

World Messianic Bible

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Revision v1.0

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Part I

The Old Testament

Genesis

¹In the beginning, God ⁱ created the heavens and the earth. ²The earth was formless and empty. Darkness was on the surface of the deep and God's Spirit was hovering over the surface of the waters. ³God said, "Let there be light," and there was light. ⁴God saw the light, and saw that it was good. God divided the light from the darkness. ⁵God called the light "day", and the darkness he called "night". There was evening and there was morning, the first day. ⁶God said, "Let there be an expanse in the middle of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters." ⁷God made the expanse, and divided the waters which were under the expanse from the waters which were above the expanse; and it was so. ⁸God called the expanse "sky". There was evening and there was morning, a second day. ⁹God said, "Let the waters under the sky be gathered together to one place, and let the dry land appear;" and it was so. ¹⁰God called the dry land "earth", and the gathering together of the waters he called "seas". God saw that it was good. ¹¹God said, "Let the earth yield grass, herbs yielding seeds, and fruit trees bearing fruit after their kind, with their seeds in it, on the earth;" and it was so. ¹²The earth yielded grass, herbs yielding seed after their kind, and trees bearing fruit, with their seeds in it, after their kind; and God saw that it was good. ¹³There was evening and there was morning, a third day. ¹⁴God said, "Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs to mark seasons, days, and years; ¹⁵and let them be for lights in the expanse of the sky to give light on the earth;" and it was so. ¹⁶God made the two great lights: the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night. He also made the stars. ¹⁷God set them in the expanse of the sky to give light to the earth, ¹⁸and to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness. God saw that it was good. ¹⁹There was evening and there was morning, a fourth day. ²⁰God said, "Let the waters abound with living creatures, and let birds fly above the earth in the open expanse of the sky." ²¹God created the large sea creatures and every living creature that moves, with which the waters swarmed, after their kind, and every winged bird after its kind. God saw that

it was good. ²²God blessed them, saying, "Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let birds multiply on the earth." ²³There was evening and there was morning, a fifth day. ²⁴God said, "Let the earth produce living creatures after their kind, livestock, creeping things, and animals of the earth after their kind;" and it was so. ²⁵God made the animals of the earth after their kind, and the livestock after their kind, and everything that creeps on the ground after its kind. God saw that it was good. ²⁶God said, "Let's make man in our image, after our likeness. Let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the birds of the sky, and over the livestock, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." ²⁷God created man in his own image. In God's image he created him; male and female he created them. ²⁸God blessed them. God said to them, "Be fruitful, multiply, fill the earth, and subdue it. Have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the sky, and over every living thing that moves on the earth." ²⁹God said, "Behold, ⁱⁱ I have given you every herb yielding seed, which is on the surface of all the earth, and every tree, which bears fruit yielding seed. It will be your food. ³⁰To every animal of the earth, and to every bird of the sky, and to everything that creeps on the earth, in which there is life, I have given every green herb for food;" and it was so. ³¹God saw everything that he had made, and, behold, it was very good. There was evening and there was morning, a sixth day.

²The heavens, the earth, and all their vast array were finished. ²On the seventh day God finished his work which he had done; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had done. ³God blessed the seventh day, and made it holy, because he rested in it from all his work of creation which he had done. ⁴This is the history of the generations of the heavens and of the earth when they were created, in the day that the LORD ⁱⁱⁱ God made the earth and the heavens. ⁵No plant of the field was yet in the earth, and no herb of the field had yet sprung up; for the LORD God had not caused it to rain on the

ⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

earth. There was not a man to till the ground,⁶ but a mist went up from the earth, and watered the whole surface of the ground.⁷ The LORD God formed man from the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.⁸ The LORD God planted a garden eastward, in Eden, and there he put the man whom he had formed.⁹ Out of the ground the LORD God made every tree to grow that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food, including the tree of life in the middle of the garden and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.¹⁰ A river went out of Eden to water the garden; and from there it was parted, and became the source of four rivers.¹¹ The name of the first is Pishon: it flows through the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold;¹² and the gold of that land is good. Bdellium^{iv} and onyx stone are also there.¹³ The name of the second river is Gihon. It is the same river that flows through the whole land of Cush.¹⁴ The name of the third river is Hiddekel. This is the one which flows in front of Assyria. The fourth river is the Euphrates.¹⁵ The LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to cultivate and keep it.¹⁶ The LORD God commanded the man, saying, “You may freely eat of every tree of the garden;¹⁷ but you shall not eat of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil; for in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die.”¹⁸ The LORD God said, “It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make him a helper comparable to^v him.”¹⁹ Out of the ground the LORD God formed every animal of the field, and every bird of the sky, and brought them to the man to see what he would call them. Whatever the man called every living creature became its name.²⁰ The man gave names to all livestock, and to the birds of the sky, and to every animal of the field; but for man there was not found a helper comparable to him.²¹ The LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep. As the man slept, he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place.²² The LORD God made a woman from the rib which he had taken from the man, and brought her to the man.²³ The man said, “This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh. She will be called ‘woman,’ because she was taken out of Man.”²⁴ Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother, and will join with his wife, and they will be one flesh.²⁵ The man and his wife were both naked, and they were not ashamed.

3 Now the serpent was more subtle than any animal of the field which the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, “Has God really said, ‘You shall not eat of any tree of the garden?’”² The woman said to the serpent, “We may eat fruit from the trees of the garden,³ but not the fruit of the tree which is in the middle of the garden. God has said, ‘You shall not eat of it. You shall not touch

it, lest you die.”⁴ The serpent said to the woman, “You won’t really die,⁵ for God knows that in the day you eat it, your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil.”⁶ When the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was to be desired to make one wise, she took some of its fruit, and ate. Then she gave some to her husband with her, and he ate it, too.⁷ Their eyes were opened, and they both knew that they were naked. They sewed fig leaves together, and made coverings for themselves.⁸ They heard the LORD God’s voice walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God among the trees of the garden.⁹ The LORD God called to the man, and said to him, “Where are you?”¹⁰ The man said, “I heard your voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; so I hid myself.”¹¹ God said, “Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?”¹² The man said, “The woman whom you gave to be with me, she gave me fruit from the tree, and I ate it.”¹³ The LORD God said to the woman, “What have you done?” The woman said, “The serpent deceived me, and I ate.”¹⁴ The LORD God said to the serpent, “Because you have done this, you are cursed above all livestock, and above every animal of the field. You shall go on your belly and you shall eat dust all the days of your life.¹⁵ I will put hostility between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel.”¹⁶ To the woman he said, “I will greatly multiply your pain in childbirth. You will bear children in pain. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you.”¹⁷ To Adam he said, “Because you have listened to your wife’s voice, and have eaten from the tree, about which I commanded you, saying, ‘You shall not eat of it,’ the ground is cursed for your sake. You will eat from it with much labor all the days of your life.¹⁸ It will yield thorns and thistles to you; and you will eat the herb of the field.¹⁹ You will eat bread by the sweat of your face until you return to the ground, for you were taken out of it. For you are dust, and you shall return to dust.”²⁰ The man called his wife Havah because she would be the mother of all the living.²¹ The LORD God made garments of animal skins for Adam and for his wife, and clothed them.²² The LORD God said, “Behold, the man has become like one of us, knowing good and evil. Now, lest he reach out his hand, and also take of the tree of life, and eat, and live forever—”²³ Therefore the LORD God sent him out from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from which he was taken.²⁴ So he drove out the man; and he placed cherubim^{vi} at the east of the garden of Eden, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to guard the way to the tree of

^{iv}or, aromatic resin

^vor, suitable for, or appropriate for.

^{vi}cherubim are powerful angelic creatures, messengers of God with wings. See Ezekiel 10.

life.

⁴The man knew ^{vii} Havah his wife. She conceived, ^{viii} and gave birth to Cain, and said, “I have gotten a man with the LORD’s help.” ²Again she gave birth, to Cain’s brother Abel. Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground. ³As time passed, Cain brought an offering to the LORD from the fruit of the ground. ⁴Abel also brought some of the firstborn of his flock and of its fat. The LORD respected Abel and his offering, ⁵but he didn’t respect Cain and his offering. Cain was very angry, and the expression on his face fell. ⁶The LORD said to Cain, “Why are you angry? Why has the expression of your face fallen? ⁷If you do well, won’t it be lifted up? If you don’t do well, sin crouches at the door. Its desire is for you, but you are to rule over it.” ⁸Cain said to Abel, his brother, “Let’s go into the field.” While they were in the field, Cain rose up against Abel, his brother, and killed him. ⁹The LORD said to Cain, “Where is Abel, your brother?” He said, “I don’t know. Am I my brother’s keeper?” ¹⁰The LORD said, “What have you done? The voice of your brother’s blood cries to me from the ground. ¹¹Now you are cursed because of the ground, which has opened its mouth to receive your brother’s blood from your hand. ¹²From now on, when you till the ground, it won’t yield its strength to you. You will be a fugitive and a wanderer in the earth.” ¹³Cain said to the LORD, “My punishment is greater than I can bear. ¹⁴Behold, you have driven me out today from the surface of the ground. I will be hidden from your face, and I will be a fugitive and a wanderer in the earth. Whoever finds me will kill me.” ¹⁵The LORD said to him, “Therefore whoever slays Cain, vengeance will be taken on him sevenfold.” The LORD appointed a sign for Cain, so that anyone finding him would not strike him. ¹⁶Cain left the LORD’s presence, and lived in the land of Nod, east of Eden. ¹⁷Cain knew his wife. She conceived, and gave birth to Enoch. He built a city, and named the city after the name of his son, Enoch. ¹⁸Irada was born to Enoch. Irada became the father of Mehujael. Mehujael became the father of Methushael. Methushael became the father of Lamech. ¹⁹Lamech took two wives: the name of the first one was Adah, and the name of the second one was Zillah. ²⁰Adah gave birth to Jabal, who was the father of those who dwell in tents and have livestock. ²¹His brother’s name was Jubal, who was the father of all who handle the harp and pipe. ²²Zillah also gave birth to Tubal Cain, the forger of every cutting instrument of bronze and iron. Tubal Cain’s sister was Naamah. ²³Lamech said to his wives, “Adah and Zillah, hear my voice. You wives of Lamech, listen to my speech, for I have slain a man for wounding me, a young man for bruising me. ²⁴If Cain will be avenged seven times, truly Lamech seventy-seven

times.” ²⁵Adam knew his wife again. She gave birth to a son, and named him Seth, saying, “for God has given me another child instead of Abel, for Cain killed him.” ²⁶A son was also born to Seth, and he named him Enosh. At that time men began to call on the LORD’s name.

⁵This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, he made him in God’s likeness. ²He created them male and female, and blessed them. On the day they were created, he named them Adam. ^{ix} ³Adam lived one hundred thirty years, and became the father of a son in his own likeness, after his image, and named him Seth. ⁴The days of Adam after he became the father of Seth were eight hundred years, and he became the father of other sons and daughters. ⁵All the days that Adam lived were nine hundred thirty years, then he died. ⁶Seth lived one hundred five years, then became the father of Enosh. ⁷Seth lived after he became the father of Enosh eight hundred seven years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ⁸All of the days of Seth were nine hundred twelve years, then he died. ⁹Enosh lived ninety years, and became the father of Kenan. ¹⁰Enosh lived after he became the father of Kenan eight hundred fifteen years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ¹¹All of the days of Enosh were nine hundred five years, then he died. ¹²Kenan lived seventy years, then became the father of Mahalalel. ¹³Kenan lived after he became the father of Mahalalel eight hundred forty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters ¹⁴and all of the days of Kenan were nine hundred ten years, then he died. ¹⁵Mahalalel lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Jared. ¹⁶Mahalalel lived after he became the father of Jared eight hundred thirty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ¹⁷All of the days of Mahalalel were eight hundred ninety-five years, then he died. ¹⁸Jared lived one hundred sixty-two years, then became the father of Enoch. ¹⁹Jared lived after he became the father of Enoch eight hundred years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ²⁰All of the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty-two years, then he died. ²¹Enoch lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Methuselah. ²²After Methuselah’s birth, Enoch walked with God for three hundred years, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ²³All the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty-five years. ²⁴Enoch walked with God, and he was not found, for God took him. ²⁵Methuselah lived one hundred eighty-seven years, then became the father of Lamech. ²⁶Methuselah lived after he became the father of Lamech seven hundred eighty-two years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ²⁷All the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty-nine years, then he died. ²⁸Lamech lived one hundred eighty-two years, then

^{vii}or, lay with, or, had relations with

^{viii}or, became pregnant

^{ix}“Adam” and “Man” are spelled with the exact same consonants in Hebrew, so this can be correctly translated either way.

became the father of a son. ²⁹He named him Noah, saying, “This one will comfort us in our work and in the toil of our hands, caused by the ground which the LORD has cursed.” ³⁰Lamech lived after he became the father of Noah five hundred ninety-five years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. ³¹All the days of Lamech were seven hundred seventy-seven years, then he died. ³²Noah was five hundred years old, then Noah became the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

6When men began to multiply on the surface of the ground, and daughters were born to them, ²God’s sons saw that men’s daughters were beautiful, and they took any that they wanted for themselves as wives. ³The LORD said, “My Spirit will not strive with man forever, because he also is flesh; so his days will be one hundred twenty years.” ⁴The Nephilim ^x were in the earth in those days, and also after that, when God’s sons came in to men’s daughters and had children with them. Those were the mighty men who were of old, men of renown. ⁵The LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of man’s heart was continually only evil. ⁶The LORD was sorry that he had made man on the earth, and it grieved him in his heart. ⁷The LORD said, “I will destroy man whom I have created from the surface of the ground—man, along with animals, creeping things, and birds of the sky—for I am sorry that I have made them.” ⁸But Noah found favor in the LORD’s eyes. ⁹This is the history of the generations of Noah: Noah was a righteous man, blameless among the people of his time. Noah walked with God. ¹⁰Noah became the father of three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. ¹¹The earth was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence. ¹²God saw the earth, and saw that it was corrupt, for all flesh had corrupted their way on the earth. ¹³God said to Noah, “I will bring an end to all flesh, for the earth is filled with violence through them. Behold, I will destroy them and the earth. ¹⁴Make a ship of gopher wood. You shall make rooms in the ship, and shall seal it inside and outside with pitch. ¹⁵This is how you shall make it. The length of the ship shall be three hundred cubits, ^{xi} its width fifty cubits, and its height thirty cubits. ¹⁶You shall make a roof in the ship, and you shall finish it to a cubit upward. You shall set the door of the ship in its side. You shall make it with lower, second, and third levels. ¹⁷I, even I, will bring the flood of waters on this earth, to destroy all flesh having the breath of life from under the sky. Everything that is in the earth will die. ¹⁸But I will establish my covenant with you. You shall come into the ship, you, your sons, your wife, and your sons’ wives with you. ¹⁹Of every living thing of all flesh,

you shall bring two of every sort into the ship, to keep them alive with you. They shall be male and female. ²⁰Of the birds after their kind, of the livestock after their kind, of every creeping thing of the ground after its kind, two of every sort will come to you, to keep them alive. ²¹Take with you some of all food that is eaten, and gather it to yourself; and it will be for food for you, and for them.” ²²Thus Noah did. He did all that God commanded him.

7The LORD said to Noah, “Come with all of your household into the ship, for I have seen your righteousness before me in this generation. ²You shall take seven pairs of every clean animal with you, the male and his female. Of the animals that are not clean, take two, the male and his female. ³Also of the birds of the sky, seven and seven, male and female, to keep seed alive on the surface of all the earth. ⁴In seven days, I will cause it to rain on the earth for forty days and forty nights. I will destroy every living thing that I have made from the surface of the ground.” ⁵Noah did everything that the LORD commanded him. ⁶Noah was six hundred years old when the flood of waters came on the earth. ⁷Noah went into the ship with his sons, his wife, and his sons’ wives, because of the floodwaters. ⁸Clean animals, unclean animals, birds, and everything that creeps on the ground ⁹went by pairs to Noah into the ship, male and female, as God commanded Noah. ¹⁰After the seven days, the floodwaters came on the earth. ¹¹In the six hundredth year of Noah’s life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month, on that day all the fountains of the great deep burst open, and the sky’s windows opened. ¹²It rained on the earth forty days and forty nights. ¹³In the same day Noah, and Shem, Ham, and Japheth—the sons of Noah—and Noah’s wife and the three wives of his sons with them, entered into the ship— ¹⁴they, and every animal after its kind, all the livestock after their kind, every creeping thing that creeps on the earth after its kind, and every bird after its kind, every bird of every sort. ¹⁵Pairs from all flesh with the breath of life in them went into the ship to Noah. ¹⁶Those who went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God commanded him; then the LORD shut him in. ¹⁷The flood was forty days on the earth. The waters increased, and lifted up the ship, and it was lifted up above the earth. ¹⁸The waters rose, and increased greatly on the earth; and the ship floated on the surface of the waters. ¹⁹The waters rose very high on the earth. All the high mountains that were under the whole sky were covered. ²⁰The waters rose fifteen cubits ^{xii} higher, and the mountains were covered. ²¹All flesh died that moved on the earth, including birds, livestock, animals, every creeping thing that creeps on the earth, and every man. ²²All on the dry land, in whose nostrils was the breath of the spirit of life, died. ²³Every living thing was

^xor, giants

^{xi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

destroyed that was on the surface of the ground, including man, livestock, creeping things, and birds of the sky. They were destroyed from the earth. Only Noah was left, and those who were with him in the ship. ²⁴The waters flooded the earth one hundred fifty days.

⁸God remembered Noah, all the animals, and all the livestock that were with him in the ship; and God made a wind to pass over the earth. The waters subsided. ²The deep's fountains and the sky's windows were also stopped, and the rain from the sky was restrained. ³The waters continually receded from the earth. After the end of one hundred fifty days the waters receded. ⁴The ship rested in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, on Ararat's mountains. ⁵The waters receded continually until the tenth month. In the tenth month, on the first day of the month, the tops of the mountains were visible. ⁶At the end of forty days, Noah opened the window of the ship which he had made, ⁷and he sent out a raven. It went back and forth, until the waters were dried up from the earth. ⁸He himself sent out a dove to see if the waters were abated from the surface of the ground, ⁹but the dove found no place to rest her foot, and she returned into the ship to him, for the waters were on the surface of the whole earth. He put out his hand, and took her, and brought her to him into the ship. ¹⁰He waited yet another seven days; and again he sent the dove out of the ship. ¹¹The dove came back to him at evening and, behold, in her mouth was a freshly plucked olive leaf. So Noah knew that the waters were abated from the earth. ¹²He waited yet another seven days, and sent out the dove; and she didn't return to him any more. ¹³In the six hundred first year, in the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were dried up from the earth. Noah removed the covering of the ship, and looked. He saw that the surface of the ground was dry. ¹⁴In the second month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month, the earth was dry. ¹⁵God spoke to Noah, saying, ¹⁶"Go out of the ship, you, your wife, your sons, and your sons' wives with you. ¹⁷Bring out with you every living thing that is with you of all flesh, including birds, livestock, and every creeping thing that creeps on the earth, that they may breed abundantly in the earth, and be fruitful, and multiply on the earth." ¹⁸Noah went out, with his sons, his wife, and his sons' wives with him. ¹⁹Every animal, every creeping thing, and every bird, whatever moves on the earth, after their families, went out of the ship. ²⁰Noah built an altar to the LORD, and took of every clean animal, and of every clean bird, and offered burnt offerings on the altar. ²¹The LORD smelled the pleasant aroma. The LORD said in his heart, "I will not again curse the ground any more for man's sake because the imagination of man's heart is evil from his youth. I will never again strike every living thing, as I have done. ²²While the earth remains, seed time and harvest, and cold

and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night will not cease."

⁹God blessed Noah and his sons, and said to them, "Be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth. ²The fear of you and the dread of you will be on every animal of the earth, and on every bird of the sky. Everything that moves along the ground, and all the fish of the sea, are delivered into your hand. ³Every moving thing that lives will be food for you. As I gave you the green herb, I have given everything to you. ⁴But flesh with its life, that is, its blood, you shall not eat. ⁵I will surely require accounting for your life's blood. At the hand of every animal I will require it. At the hand of man, even at the hand of every man's brother, I will require the life of man. ⁶Whoever sheds man's blood, his blood will be shed by man, for God made man in his own image. ⁷Be fruitful and multiply. Increase abundantly in the earth, and multiply in it." ⁸God spoke to Noah and to his sons with him, saying, ⁹"As for me, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your offspring after you, ¹⁰and with every living creature that is with you: the birds, the livestock, and every animal of the earth with you, of all that go out of the ship, even every animal of the earth. ¹¹I will establish my covenant with you: All flesh will not be cut off any more by the waters of the flood. There will never again be a flood to destroy the earth." ¹²God said, "This is the token of the covenant which I make between me and you and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations: ¹³I set my rainbow in the cloud, and it will be a sign of a covenant between me and the earth. ¹⁴When I bring a cloud over the earth, that the rainbow will be seen in the cloud, ¹⁵I will remember my covenant, which is between me and you and every living creature of all flesh, and the waters will no more become a flood to destroy all flesh. ¹⁶The rainbow will be in the cloud. I will look at it, that I may remember the everlasting covenant between God and every living creature of all flesh that is on the earth." ¹⁷God said to Noah, "This is the token of the covenant which I have established between me and all flesh that is on the earth." ¹⁸The sons of Noah who went out from the ship were Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Ham is the father of Canaan. ¹⁹These three were the sons of Noah, and from these the whole earth was populated. ²⁰Noah began to be a farmer, and planted a vineyard. ²¹He drank of the wine and got drunk. He was uncovered within his tent. ²²Ham, the father of Canaan, saw the nakedness of his father, and told his two brothers outside. ²³Shem and Japheth took a garment, and laid it on both their shoulders, went in backwards, and covered the nakedness of their father. Their faces were backwards, and they didn't see their father's nakedness. ²⁴Noah awoke from his wine, and knew what his youngest son had done to him. ²⁵He said, "Canaan is cursed. He will be a servant of servants to his broth-

ers.” ²⁶He said, “Blessed be the LORD, the God of Shem. Let Canaan be his servant. ²⁷May God enlarge Japheth. Let him dwell in the tents of Shem. Let Canaan be his servant.” ²⁸Noah lived three hundred fifty years after the flood. ²⁹All the days of Noah were nine hundred fifty years, and then he died.

10Now this is the history of the generations of the sons of Noah and of Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Sons were born to them after the flood. ²The sons of Japheth were: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras. ³The sons of Gomer were: Ashkenaz, Riphath, and Togarmah. ⁴The sons of Javan were: Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim. ⁵Of these were the islands of the nations divided in their lands, everyone after his language, after their families, in their nations. ⁶The sons of Ham were: Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan. ⁷The sons of Cush were: Seba, Havilah, Sabtah, Raamah, and Sabteca. The sons of Raamah were: Sheba and Dedan. ⁸Cush became the father of Nimrod. He began to be a mighty one in the earth. ⁹He was a mighty hunter before the LORD. Therefore it is said, “like Nimrod, a mighty hunter before the LORD”. ¹⁰The beginning of his kingdom was Babel, Erech, Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar. ¹¹Out of that land he went into Assyria, and built Nineveh, Rehoboth Ir, Calah, ¹²and Resen between Nineveh and the great city Calah. ¹³Mizraim became the father of Ludim, Anamim, Lehabim, Naphtuhim, ¹⁴Pathrusim, Casluhim (which the Philistines descended from), and Caphtorim. ¹⁵Canaan became the father of Sidon (his firstborn), Heth, ¹⁶the Jebusites, the Amorites, the Girgashites, ¹⁷the Hivites, the Arkites, the Sinites, ¹⁸the Arvadites, the Zemarites, and the Hamathites. Afterward the families of the Canaanites were spread abroad. ¹⁹The border of the Canaanites was from Sidon—as you go toward Gerar—to Gaza—as you go toward Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboiim—to Lasha. ²⁰These are the sons of Ham, after their families, according to their languages, in their lands and their nations. ²¹Children were also born to Shem (the elder brother of Japheth), the father of all the children of Eber. ²²The sons of Shem were: Elam, Asshur, Arpachshad, Lud, and Aram. ²³The sons of Aram were: Uz, Hul, Gether, and Mash. ²⁴Arpachshad became the father of Shelah. Shelah became the father of Eber. ²⁵To Eber were born two sons. The name of the one was Peleg, for in his days the earth was divided. His brother’s name was Joktan. ²⁶Joktan became the father of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, ²⁷Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, ²⁸Obal, Abimael, Sheba, ²⁹Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan. ³⁰Their dwelling extended from Mesha, as you go toward Sephar, the mountain of the east. ³¹These are the sons of Shem, by their families, according to their languages, lands, and nations. ³²These are the families of the sons of Noah, by their generations, accord-

ing to their nations. The nations divided from these in the earth after the flood.

11The whole earth was of one language and of one speech. ²As they traveled east, ^{xiii} they found a plain in the land of Shinar, and they lived there. ³They said to one another, “Come, let’s make bricks, and burn them thoroughly.” They had brick for stone, and they used tar for mortar. ⁴They said, “Come, let’s build ourselves a city, and a tower whose top reaches to the sky, and let’s make a name for ourselves, lest we be scattered abroad on the surface of the whole earth.” ⁵The LORD came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of men built. ⁶The LORD said, “Behold, they are one people, and they all have one language, and this is what they begin to do. Now nothing will be withheld from them, which they intend to do. ⁷Come, let’s go down, and there confuse their language, that they may not understand one another’s speech.” ⁸So the LORD scattered them abroad from there on the surface of all the earth. They stopped building the city. ⁹Therefore its name was called Babel, because there the LORD confused the language of all the earth. From there, the LORD scattered them abroad on the surface of all the earth. ¹⁰This is the history of the generations of Shem: Shem was one hundred years old when he became the father of Arpachshad two years after the flood. ¹¹Shem lived five hundred years after he became the father of Arpachshad, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ¹²Arpachshad lived thirty-five years and became the father of Shelah. ¹³Arpachshad lived four hundred three years after he became the father of Shelah, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ¹⁴Shelah lived thirty years, and became the father of Eber. ¹⁵Shelah lived four hundred three years after he became the father of Eber, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ¹⁶Eber lived thirty-four years, and became the father of Peleg. ¹⁷Eber lived four hundred thirty years after he became the father of Peleg, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ¹⁸Peleg lived thirty years, and became the father of Reu. ¹⁹Peleg lived two hundred nine years after he became the father of Reu, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ²⁰Reu lived thirty-two years, and became the father of Serug. ²¹Reu lived two hundred seven years after he became the father of Serug, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ²²Serug lived thirty years, and became the father of Nahor. ²³Serug lived two hundred years after he became the father of Nahor, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ²⁴Nahor lived twenty-nine years, and became the father of Terah. ²⁵Nahor lived one hundred nineteen years after he became the father of Terah, and became the father of more sons and daughters. ²⁶Terah lived seventy years, and became the father of Abram, Nahor, and Ha-

^{xiii}LXX reads “from the east”.

ran. ²⁷Now this is the history of the generations of Terah. Terah became the father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran. Haran became the father of Lot. ²⁸Haran died in the land of his birth, in Ur-Kasdim, while his father Terah was still alive. ²⁹Abram and Nahor married wives. The name of Abram's wife was Sarai, and the name of Nahor's wife was Milcah, the daughter of Haran, who was also the father of Iscah. ³⁰Sarai was barren. She had no child. ³¹Terah took Abram his son, Lot the son of Haran, his son's son, and Sarai his daughter-in-law, his son Abram's wife. They went from Ur-Kasdim, to go into the land of Canaan. They came to Haran and lived there. ³²The days of Terah were two hundred five years. Terah died in Haran.

12Now the LORD said to Abram, "Leave your country, and your relatives, and your father's house, and go to the land that I will show you. ²I will make of you a great nation. I will bless you and make your name great. You will be a blessing. ³I will bless those who bless you, and I will curse him who treats you with contempt. All the families of the earth will be blessed through you." ⁴So Abram went, as the LORD had told him. Lot went with him. Abram was seventy-five years old when he departed from Haran. ⁵Abram took Sarai his wife, Lot his brother's son, all their possessions that they had gathered, and the people whom they had acquired in Haran, and they went to go into the land of Canaan. They entered into the land of Canaan. ⁶Abram passed through the land to the place of Shechem, to the oak of Moreh. At that time, Canaanites were in the land. ⁷The LORD appeared to Abram and said, "I will give this land to your offspring." ^{xiv} He built an altar there to the LORD, who had appeared to him. ⁸He left from there to go to the mountain on the east of Bethel and pitched his tent, having Bethel on the west, and Ai on the east. There he built an altar to the LORD and called on the LORD's name. ⁹Abram traveled, still going on toward the South. ¹⁰There was a famine in the land. Abram went down into Egypt to live as a foreigner there, for the famine was severe in the land. ¹¹When he had come near to enter Egypt, he said to Sarai his wife, "See now, I know that you are a beautiful woman to look at. ¹²It will happen that when the Egyptians see you, they will say, 'This is his wife.' They will kill me, but they will save you alive. ¹³Please say that you are my sister, that it may be well with me for your sake, and that my soul may live because of you." ¹⁴When Abram had come into Egypt, Egyptians saw that the woman was very beautiful. ¹⁵The princes of Pharaoh saw her, and praised her to Pharaoh; and the woman was taken into Pharaoh's house. ¹⁶He dealt well with Abram for her sake. He had sheep, cattle, male donkeys, male servants, female servants, female donkeys, and camels. ¹⁷The LORD afflicted Pharaoh and his house with great plagues because of Sarai, Abram's wife. ¹⁸Pharaoh

^{xiv}or, seed

called Abram and said, "What is this that you have done to me? Why didn't you tell me that she was your wife? ¹⁹Why did you say, 'She is my sister,' so that I took her to be my wife? Now therefore, see your wife, take her, and go your way." ²⁰Pharaoh commanded men concerning him, and they escorted him away with his wife and all that he had.

13Abram went up out of Egypt—he, his wife, all that he had, and Lot with him—into the South. ²Abram was very rich in livestock, in silver, and in gold. ³He went on his journeys from the South as far as Bethel, to the place where his tent had been at the beginning, between Bethel and Ai, ⁴to the place of the altar, which he had made there at the first. There Abram called on the LORD's name. ⁵Lot also, who went with Abram, had flocks, herds, and tents. ⁶The land was not able to bear them, that they might live together; for their possessions were so great that they couldn't live together. ⁷There was strife between the herdsmen of Abram's livestock and the herdsmen of Lot's livestock. The Canaanites and the Perizzites lived in the land at that time. ⁸Abram said to Lot, "Please, let there be no strife between you and me, and between your herdsmen and my herdsmen; for we are relatives. ⁹Isn't the whole land before you? Please separate yourself from me. If you go to the left hand, then I will go to the right. Or if you go to the right hand, then I will go to the left." ¹⁰Lot lifted up his eyes, and saw all the plain of the Jordan, that it was well-watered everywhere, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as you go to Zoar. ¹¹So Lot chose the Plain of the Jordan for himself. Lot traveled east, and they separated themselves from one other. ¹²Abram lived in the land of Canaan, and Lot lived in the cities of the plain, and moved his tent as far as Sodom. ¹³Now the men of Sodom were exceedingly wicked and sinners against the LORD. ¹⁴The LORD said to Abram, after Lot was separated from him, "Now, lift up your eyes, and look from the place where you are, northward and southward and eastward and westward, ¹⁵for I will give all the land which you see to you and to your offspring forever. ¹⁶I will make your offspring as the dust of the earth, so that if a man can count the dust of the earth, then your offspring may also be counted. ¹⁷Arise, walk through the land in its length and in its width; for I will give it to you." ¹⁸Abram moved his tent, and came and lived by the oaks of Mamre, which are in Hebron, and built an altar there to the LORD.

14In the days of Amraphel, king of Shinar; Arioch, king of Ellasar; Chedorlaomer, king of Elam; and Tidal, king of Goiim, ²they made war with Bera, king of Sodom; Birsha, king of Gomorrah; Shinab, king of Admah; Shemeber, king of Zeboiim; and the king of Bela (also called Zoar). ³All

these joined together in the valley of Siddim (also called the Salt Sea). ⁴They served Chedorlaomer for twelve years, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled. ⁵In the fourteenth year Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him came and struck the Rephaim in Ashteroth Karnaim, the Zuzim in Ham, the Emim in Shaveh Kiriathaim, ⁶and the Horites in their Mount Seir, to El Paran, which is by the wilderness. ⁷They returned, and came to En Mishpat (also called Kadesh), and struck all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites, that lived in Hazazon Tamar. ⁸The king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (also called Zoar) went out; and they set the battle in array against them in the valley of Siddim ⁹against Chedorlaomer king of Elam, Tidal king of Goiim, Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar; four kings against the five. ¹⁰Now the valley of Siddim was full of tar pits; and the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, and some fell there. Those who remained fled to the hills. ¹¹They took all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah, and all their food, and went their way. ¹²They took Lot, Abram's brother's son, who lived in Sodom, and his goods, and departed. ¹³One who had escaped came and told Abram, the Hebrew. At that time, he lived by the oaks of Mamre, the Amorite, brother of Eshcol and brother of Aner. They were allies of Abram. ¹⁴When Abram heard that his relative was taken captive, he led out his three hundred eighteen trained men, born in his house, and pursued as far as Dan. ¹⁵He divided himself against them by night, he and his servants, and struck them, and pursued them to Hobah, which is on the left hand of Damascus. ¹⁶He brought back all the goods, and also brought back his relative Lot and his goods, and the women also, and the other people. ¹⁷The king of Sodom went out to meet him after his return from the slaughter of Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him, at the valley of Shaveh (that is, the King's Valley). ¹⁸Melchizedek king of Salem brought out bread and wine. He was priest of God Most High. ¹⁹He blessed him, and said, "Blessed be Abram of God Most High, possessor of heaven and earth. ²⁰Blessed be God Most High, who has delivered your enemies into your hand." Abram gave him a tenth of all. ²¹The king of Sodom said to Abram, "Give me the people, and take the goods for yourself." ²²Abram said to the king of Sodom, "I have lifted up my hand to the LORD, God Most High, possessor of heaven and earth, ²³that I will not take a thread nor a sandal strap nor anything that is yours, lest you should say, 'I have made Abram rich.' ²⁴I will accept nothing from you except that which the young men have eaten, and the portion of the men who went with me: Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. Let them take their portion."

15After these things the LORD's word came to Abram in a vision, saying, "Don't be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward." ²Abram said, "Lord

^{xv} GOD, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?" ³Abram said, "Behold, you have given no children to me: and, behold, one born in my house is my heir." ⁴Behold, the LORD's word came to him, saying, "This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir." ⁵The LORD brought him outside, and said, "Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them." He said to Abram, "So your offspring will be." ⁶He believed in the LORD, who credited it to him for righteousness. ⁷He said to Abram, "I am the LORD who brought you out of Ur-Kasdim, to give you this land to inherit it." ⁸He said, "Lord GOD, how will I know that I will inherit it?" ⁹He said to him, "Bring me a heifer three years old, a female goat three years old, a ram three years old, a turtledove, and a young pigeon." ¹⁰He brought him all these, and divided them in the middle, and laid each half opposite the other; but he didn't divide the birds. ¹¹The birds of prey came down on the carcasses, and Abram drove them away. ¹²When the sun was going down, a deep sleep fell on Abram. Now terror and great darkness fell on him. ¹³He said to Abram, "Know for sure that your offspring will live as foreigners in a land that is not theirs, and will serve them. They will afflict them four hundred years. ¹⁴I will also judge that nation, whom they will serve. Afterward they will come out with great wealth; ¹⁵but you will go to your fathers in peace. You will be buried at a good old age. ¹⁶In the fourth generation they will come here again, for the iniquity of the Amorite is not yet full." ¹⁷It came to pass that, when the sun went down, and it was dark, behold, a smoking furnace and a flaming torch passed between these pieces. ¹⁸In that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying, "I have given this land to your offspring, from the river of Egypt to the great river, the river Euphrates: ¹⁹the land of the Kenites, the Kenizzites, the Kadmonites, ²⁰the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Rephaim, ²¹the Amorites, the Canaanites, the Girgashites, and the Jebusites."

16Now Sarai, Abram's wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar. ²Sarai said to Abram, "See now, the LORD has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her." Abram listened to the voice of Sarai. ³Sarai, Abram's wife, took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, after Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴He went in to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes. ⁵Sarai said to Abram, "This wrong is your fault. I gave my servant into your bosom, and when she saw that she had conceived, she despised me. May The LORD judge between me and you." ⁶But Abram said to Sarai,

^{xv}The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai".

“Behold, your maid is in your hand. Do to her whatever is good in your eyes.” Sarai dealt harshly with her, and she fled from her face. ⁷The LORD’s angel found her by a fountain of water in the wilderness, by the fountain on the way to Shur. ⁸He said, “Hagar, Sarai’s servant, where did you come from? Where are you going?” She said, “I am fleeing from the face of my mistress Sarai.” ⁹The LORD’s angel said to her, “Return to your mistress, and submit yourself under her hands.” ¹⁰The LORD’s angel said to her, “I will greatly multiply your offspring, that they will not be counted for multitude.” ¹¹The LORD’s angel said to her, “Behold, you are with child, and will bear a son. You shall call his name Ishmael, because the LORD has heard your affliction. ¹²He will be like a wild donkey among men. His hand will be against every man, and every man’s hand against him. He will live opposed to all of his brothers.” ¹³She called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, “You are a God who sees,” for she said, “Have I even stayed alive after seeing him?” ¹⁴Therefore the well was called Beer Lahai Roi. ^{xvi} Behold, it is between Kadesh and Bered. ¹⁵Hagar bore a son for Abram. Abram called the name of his son, whom Hagar bore, Ishmael. ¹⁶Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram.

17When Abram was ninety-nine years old, the LORD appeared to Abram and said to him, “I am God Almighty. Walk before me and be blameless. ²I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.” ³Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴“As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations. ⁵Your name will no more be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁶I will make you exceedingly fruitful, and I will make nations of you. Kings will come out of you. ⁷I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be a God to you and to your offspring after you. ⁸I will give to you, and to your offspring after you, the land where you are traveling, all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession. I will be their God.” ⁹God said to Abraham, “As for you, you shall keep my covenant, you and your offspring after you throughout their generations. ¹⁰This is my covenant, which you shall keep, between me and you and your offspring after you. Every male among you shall be circumcised. ¹¹You shall be circumcised in the flesh of your foreskin. It will be a token of the covenant between me and you. ¹²He who is eight days old shall be circumcised among you, every male throughout your generations, he who is born in the house, or bought with money from any foreigner who is not of your offspring. ¹³He who is born in your house, and he who is bought with your money, must be circumcised. My covenant shall

be in your flesh for an everlasting covenant. ¹⁴The uncircumcised male who is not circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin, that soul shall be cut off from his people. He has broken my covenant.” ¹⁵God said to Abraham, “As for Sarai your wife, you shall not call her name Sarai, but her name shall be Sarah. ¹⁶I will bless her, and moreover I will give you a son by her. Yes, I will bless her, and she will be a mother of nations. Kings of peoples will come from her.” ¹⁷Then Abraham fell on his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, “Will a child be born to him who is one hundred years old? Will Sarah, who is ninety years old, give birth?” ¹⁸Abraham said to God, “Oh that Ishmael might live before you!” ¹⁹God said, “No, but Sarah, your wife, will bear you a son. You shall call his name Isaac. ^{xvii} I will establish my covenant with him for an everlasting covenant for his offspring after him. ²⁰As for Ishmael, I have heard you. Behold, I have blessed him, and will make him fruitful, and will multiply him exceedingly. He will become the father of twelve princes, and I will make him a great nation. ²¹But I will establish my covenant with Isaac, whom Sarah will bear to you at this set time next year.” ²²When he finished talking with him, God went up from Abraham. ²³Abraham took Ishmael his son, all who were born in his house, and all who were bought with his money: every male among the men of Abraham’s house, and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in the same day, as God had said to him. ²⁴Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin. ²⁵Ishmael, his son, was thirteen years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin. ²⁶In the same day both Abraham and Ishmael, his son, were circumcised. ²⁷All the men of his house, those born in the house, and those bought with money from a foreigner, were circumcised with him.

18The LORD appeared to him by the oaks of Mamre, as he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day. ²He lifted up his eyes and looked, and saw that three men stood near him. When he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself to the earth, ³and said, “My lord, if now I have found favor in your sight, please don’t go away from your servant. ⁴Now let a little water be fetched, wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree. ⁵I will get a piece of bread so you can refresh your heart. After that you may go your way, now that you have come to your servant.” They said, “Very well, do as you have said.” ⁶Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah, and said, “Quickly prepare three seahs ^{xviii} of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes.” ⁷Abraham ran to the herd, and fetched a tender and good calf, and gave it to the servant. He hurried to dress it. ⁸He took butter, milk, and the calf which he had dressed, and set it before them. He stood

^{xvi}Beer Lahai Roi means “well of the one who lives and sees me”.

^{xvii}Isaac means “he laughs”.

^{xviii}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

by them under the tree, and they ate. ⁹They asked him, "Where is Sarah, your wife?" He said, "There, in the tent." ¹⁰He said, "I will certainly return to you at about this time next year; and behold, Sarah your wife will have a son." Sarah heard in the tent door, which was behind him. ¹¹Now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in age. Sarah had passed the age of childbearing. ¹²Sarah laughed within herself, saying, "After I have grown old will I have pleasure, my lord being old also?" ¹³The LORD said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh, saying, 'Will I really bear a child when I am old?' ¹⁴Is anything too hard for the LORD? At the set time I will return to you, when the season comes around, and Sarah will have a son." ¹⁵Then Sarah denied it, saying, "I didn't laugh," for she was afraid. He said, "No, but you did laugh." ¹⁶The men rose up from there, and looked toward Sodom. Abraham went with them to see them on their way. ¹⁷The LORD said, "Will I hide from Abraham what I do, ¹⁸since Abraham will surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth will be blessed in him? ¹⁹For I have known him, to the end that he may command his children and his household after him, that they may keep the way of the LORD, to do righteousness and justice; to the end that the LORD may bring on Abraham that which he has spoken of him." ²⁰The LORD said, "Because the cry of Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grievous, ²¹I will go down now, and see whether their deeds are as bad as the reports which have come to me. If not, I will know." ²²The men turned from there, and went toward Sodom, but Abraham stood yet before the LORD. ²³Abraham came near, and said, "Will you consume the righteous with the wicked? ²⁴What if there are fifty righteous within the city? Will you consume and not spare the place for the fifty righteous who are in it? ²⁵May it be far from you to do things like that, to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous should be like the wicked. May that be far from you. Shouldn't the Judge of all the earth do right?" ²⁶The LORD said, "If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare the whole place for their sake." ²⁷Abraham answered, "See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord, although I am dust and ashes. ²⁸What if there will lack five of the fifty righteous? Will you destroy all the city for lack of five?" He said, "I will not destroy it if I find forty-five there." ²⁹He spoke to him yet again, and said, "What if there are forty found there?" He said, "I will not do it for the forty's sake." ³⁰He said, "Oh don't let the Lord be angry, and I will speak. What if there are thirty found there?" He said, "I will not do it if I find thirty there." ³¹He said, "See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord. What if there are twenty found there?" He said, "I will not destroy it for the twenty's sake." ³²He said, "Oh don't let the Lord be angry, and I will speak just once more. What if ten are found there?" He said, "I will

not destroy it for the ten's sake." ³³The LORD went his way as soon as he had finished communing with Abraham, and Abraham returned to his place.

¹⁹The two angels came to Sodom at evening. Lot sat in the gate of Sodom. Lot saw them, and rose up to meet them. He bowed himself with his face to the earth, ²and he said, "See now, my lords, please come into your servant's house, stay all night, wash your feet, and you can rise up early, and go on your way." They said, "No, but we will stay in the street all night." ³He urged them greatly, and they came in with him, and entered into his house. He made them a feast, and baked unleavened bread, and they ate. ⁴But before they lay down, the men of the city, the men of Sodom, surrounded the house, both young and old, all the people from every quarter. ⁵They called to Lot, and said to him, "Where are the men who came in to you this night? Bring them out to us, that we may have sex with them." ⁶Lot went out to them through the door, and shut the door after himself. ⁷He said, "Please, my brothers, don't act so wickedly. ⁸See now, I have two virgin daughters. Please let me bring them out to you, and you may do to them what seems good to you. Only don't do anything to these men, because they have come under the shadow of my roof." ⁹They said, "Stand back!" Then they said, "This one fellow came in to live as a foreigner, and he appoints himself a judge. Now we will deal worse with you than with them!" They pressed hard on the man Lot, and came near to break the door. ¹⁰But the men reached out their hand, and brought Lot into the house to them, and shut the door. ¹¹They struck the men who were at the door of the house with blindness, both small and great, so that they wearied themselves to find the door. ¹²The men said to Lot, "Do you have anybody else here? Sons-in-law, your sons, your daughters, and whomever you have in the city, bring them out of the place: ¹³for we will destroy this place, because the outcry against them has grown so great before the LORD that the LORD has sent us to destroy it." ¹⁴Lot went out, and spoke to his sons-in-law, who were pledged to marry his daughters, and said, "Get up! Get out of this place, for the LORD will destroy the city!" But he seemed to his sons-in-law to be joking. ¹⁵When the morning came, then the angels hurried Lot, saying, "Get up! Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, lest you be consumed in the iniquity of the city." ¹⁶But he lingered; and the men grabbed his hand, his wife's hand, and his two daughters' hands, the LORD being merciful to him; and they took him out, and set him outside of the city. ¹⁷It came to pass, when they had taken them out, that he said, "Escape for your life! Don't look behind you, and don't stay anywhere in the plain. Escape to the mountains, lest you be consumed!" ¹⁸Lot said to them, "Oh, not so, my lord. ¹⁹See now, your servant has found favor in your sight, and you have magnified your loving kindness, which

you have shown to me in saving my life. I can't escape to the mountain, lest evil overtake me, and I die. ²⁰See now, this city is near to flee to, and it is a little one. Oh let me escape there (isn't it a little one?), and my soul will live." ²¹He said to him, "Behold, I have granted your request concerning this thing also, that I will not overthrow the city of which you have spoken. ²²Hurry, escape there, for I can't do anything until you get there." Therefore the name of the city was called Zoar. ^{xix} ²³The sun had risen on the earth when Lot came to Zoar. ²⁴Then the LORD rained on Sodom and on Gomorrah sulfur and fire from the LORD out of the sky. ²⁵He overthrew those cities, all the plain, all the inhabitants of the cities, and that which grew on the ground. ²⁶But Lot's wife looked back from behind him, and she became a pillar of salt. ²⁷Abraham went up early in the morning to the place where he had stood before the LORD. ²⁸He looked toward Sodom and Gomorrah, and toward all the land of the plain, and saw that the smoke of the land went up as the smoke of a furnace. ²⁹When God destroyed the cities of the plain, God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out of the middle of the overthrow, when he overthrew the cities in which Lot lived. ³⁰Lot went up out of Zoar, and lived in the mountain, and his two daughters with him; for he was afraid to live in Zoar. He lived in a cave with his two daughters. ³¹The firstborn said to the younger, "Our father is old, and there is not a man in the earth to come in to us in the way of all the earth. ³²Come, let's make our father drink wine, and we will lie with him, that we may preserve our father's family line." ³³They made their father drink wine that night: and the firstborn went in, and lay with her father. He didn't know when she lay down, nor when she arose. ³⁴It came to pass on the next day, that the firstborn said to the younger, "Behold, I lay last night with my father. Let's make him drink wine again tonight. You go in, and lie with him, that we may preserve our father's family line." ³⁵They made their father drink wine that night also. The younger went and lay with him. He didn't know when she lay down, nor when she got up. ³⁶Thus both of Lot's daughters were with child by their father. ³⁷The firstborn bore a son, and named him Moab. He is the father of the Moabites to this day. ³⁸The younger also bore a son, and called his name Ben Ammi. He is the father of the children of Ammon to this day.

20 Abraham traveled from there toward the land of the South, and lived between Kadesh and Shur. He lived as a foreigner in Gerar. ²Abraham said about Sarah his wife, "She is my sister." Abimelech king of Gerar sent, and took Sarah. ³But God came to Abimelech in a dream of the night, and said to him, "Behold, you are a dead man, because of the woman whom you have taken; for she is a man's wife." ⁴Now Abimelech had not come near her. He

said, "Lord, will you kill even a righteous nation? ⁵Didn't he tell me, 'She is my sister'? She, even she herself, said, 'He is my brother.' I have done this in the integrity of my heart and the innocence of my hands." ⁶God said to him in the dream, "Yes, I know that in the integrity of your heart you have done this, and I also withheld you from sinning against me. Therefore I didn't allow you to touch her. ⁷Now therefore, restore the man's wife. For he is a prophet, and he will pray for you, and you will live. If you don't restore her, know for sure that you will die, you, and all who are yours." ⁸Abimelech rose early in the morning, and called all his servants, and told all these things in their ear. The men were very scared. ⁹Then Abimelech called Abraham, and said to him, "What have you done to us? How have I sinned against you, that you have brought on me and on my kingdom a great sin? You have done deeds to me that ought not to be done!" ¹⁰Abimelech said to Abraham, "What did you see, that you have done this thing?" ¹¹Abraham said, "Because I thought, 'Surely the fear of God is not in this place. They will kill me for my wife's sake.' ¹²Besides, she is indeed my sister, the daughter of my father, but not the daughter of my mother; and she became my wife. ¹³When God caused me to wander from my father's house, I said to her, 'This is your kindness which you shall show to me. Everywhere that we go, say of me, 'He is my brother.''" ¹⁴Abimelech took sheep and cattle, male servants and female servants, and gave them to Abraham, and restored Sarah, his wife, to him. ¹⁵Abimelech said, "Behold, my land is before you. Dwell where it pleases you." ¹⁶To Sarah he said, "Behold, I have given your brother a thousand pieces of silver. Behold, it is for you a covering of the eyes to all that are with you. In front of all you are vindicated." ¹⁷Abraham prayed to God. So God healed Abimelech, his wife, and his female servants, and they bore children. ¹⁸For the LORD had closed up tight all the wombs of the house of Abimelech, because of Sarah, Abraham's wife.

21 The LORD visited Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did to Sarah as he had spoken. ²Sarah conceived, and bore Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him. ³Abraham called his son who was born to him, whom Sarah bore to him, Isaac. ^{xx} ⁴Abraham circumcised his son, Isaac, when he was eight days old, as God had commanded him. ⁵Abraham was one hundred years old when his son, Isaac, was born to him. ⁶Sarah said, "God has made me laugh. Everyone who hears will laugh with me." ⁷She said, "Who would have said to Abraham that Sarah would nurse children? For I have borne him a son in his old age." ⁸The child grew and was weaned. Abraham made a great feast on the day that Isaac was weaned. ⁹Sarah saw the son of Hagar the Egyptian, whom she had borne to Abraham,

^{xix}Zoar means "little".

^{xx}Isaac means "He laughs".

mocking. ¹⁰Therefore she said to Abraham, “Cast out this servant and her son! For the son of this servant will not be heir with my son, Isaac.” ¹¹The thing was very grievous in Abraham’s sight on account of his son. ¹²God said to Abraham, “Don’t let it be grievous in your sight because of the boy, and because of your servant. In all that Sarah says to you, listen to her voice. For your offspring will be named through Isaac. ¹³I will also make a nation of the son of the servant, because he is your child.” ¹⁴Abraham rose up early in the morning, and took bread and a container of water, and gave it to Hagar, putting it on her shoulder; and gave her the child, and sent her away. She departed, and wandered in the wilderness of Beersheba. ¹⁵The water in the container was spent, and she put the child under one of the shrubs. ¹⁶She went and sat down opposite him, a good way off, about a bow shot away. For she said, “Don’t let me see the death of the child.” She sat opposite him, and lifted up her voice, and wept. ¹⁷God heard the voice of the boy. The angel of God called to Hagar out of the sky, and said to her, “What troubles you, Hagar? Don’t be afraid. For God has heard the voice of the boy where he is. ¹⁸Get up, lift up the boy, and hold him with your hand. For I will make him a great nation.” ¹⁹God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water. She went, filled the container with water, and gave the boy a drink. ²⁰God was with the boy, and he grew. He lived in the wilderness, and as he grew up, he became an archer. ²¹He lived in the wilderness of Paran. His mother got a wife for him out of the land of Egypt. ²²At that time, Abimelech and Phicol the captain of his army spoke to Abraham, saying, “God is with you in all that you do. ²³Now, therefore, swear to me here by God that you will not deal falsely with me, nor with my son, nor with my son’s son. But according to the kindness that I have done to you, you shall do to me, and to the land in which you have lived as a foreigner.” ²⁴Abraham said, “I will swear.” ²⁵Abraham complained to Abimelech because of a water well, which Abimelech’s servants had violently taken away. ²⁶Abimelech said, “I don’t know who has done this thing. You didn’t tell me, and I didn’t hear of it until today.” ²⁷Abraham took sheep and cattle, and gave them to Abimelech. Those two made a covenant. ²⁸Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the flock by themselves. ²⁹Abimelech said to Abraham, “What do these seven ewe lambs, which you have set by themselves, mean?” ³⁰He said, “You shall take these seven ewe lambs from my hand, that it may be a witness to me, that I have dug this well.” ³¹Therefore he called that place Beersheba, ^{xxi} because they both swore an oath there. ³²So they made a covenant at Beersheba. Abimelech rose up with Phicol, the captain of his army, and they returned into the land of the Philistines. ³³Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in Beersheba, and there he called on the name of the LORD, the Everlasting God. ³⁴Abraham lived as a foreigner in

the land of the Philistines many days.

22After these things, God tested Abraham, and said to him, “Abraham!” He said, “Here I am.” ²He said, “Now take your son, your only son, Isaac, whom you love, and go into the land of Moriah. Offer him there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains which I will tell you of.” ³Abraham rose early in the morning, and saddled his donkey; and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son. He split the wood for the burnt offering, and rose up, and went to the place of which God had told him. ⁴On the third day Abraham lifted up his eyes, and saw the place far off. ⁵Abraham said to his young men, “Stay here with the donkey. The boy and I will go over there. We will worship, and come back to you.” ⁶Abraham took the wood of the burnt offering and laid it on Isaac his son. He took in his hand the fire and the knife. They both went together. ⁷Isaac spoke to Abraham his father, and said, “My father?” He said, “Here I am, my son.” He said, “Here is the fire and the wood, but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?” ⁸Abraham said, “God will provide himself the lamb for a burnt offering, my son.” So they both went together. ⁹They came to the place which God had told him of. Abraham built the altar there, and laid the wood in order, bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar, on the wood. ¹⁰Abraham stretched out his hand, and took the knife to kill his son. ¹¹The LORD’s angel called to him out of the sky, and said, “Abraham, Abraham!” He said, “Here I am.” ¹²He said, “Don’t lay your hand on the boy or do anything to him. For now I know that you fear God, since you have not withheld your son, your only son, from me.” ¹³Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and saw that behind him was a ram caught in the thicket by his horns. Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering instead of his son. ¹⁴Abraham called the name of that place “The LORD Will Provide”. ^{xxii} As it is said to this day, “On the LORD’s mountain, it will be provided.” ¹⁵The LORD’s angel called to Abraham a second time out of the sky, ¹⁶and said, “‘I have sworn by myself,’ says the LORD, ‘because you have done this thing, and have not withheld your son, your only son, ¹⁷that I will bless you greatly, and I will multiply your offspring greatly like the stars of the heavens, and like the sand which is on the seashore. Your offspring will possess the gate of his enemies. ¹⁸All the nations of the earth will be blessed by your offspring, because you have obeyed my voice.’” ¹⁹So Abraham returned to his young men, and they rose up and went together to Beersheba. Abraham lived at Beersheba. ²⁰After these things, Abraham was told, “Behold, Milcah, she also has borne children to your brother Nahor: ²¹Uz his firstborn, Buz his brother, Kemuel the father of Aram, ²²Chesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, and Bethuel.” ²³Bethuel became the fa-

^{xxi}Beersheba can mean “well of the oath” or “well of seven”.

^{xxii}or, the LORD Jireh, or, the LORD Seeing

ther of Rebekah. These eight Milcah bore to Nahor, Abraham's brother. ²⁴His concubine, whose name was Reumah, also bore Tebah, Gaham, Tahash, and Maacah.

²³Sarah lived one hundred twenty-seven years. This was the length of Sarah's life. ²Sarah died in Kiriath Arba (also called Hebron), in the land of Canaan. Abraham came to mourn for Sarah, and to weep for her. ³Abraham rose up from before his dead and spoke to the children of Heth, saying, ⁴"I am a stranger and a foreigner living with you. Give me a possession of a burying-place with you, that I may bury my dead out of my sight." ⁵The children of Heth answered Abraham, saying to him, ⁶"Hear us, my lord. You are a prince of God among us. Bury your dead in the best of our tombs. None of us will withhold from you his tomb. Bury your dead." ⁷Abraham rose up, and bowed himself to the people of the land, to the children of Heth. ⁸He talked with them, saying, "If you agree that I should bury my dead out of my sight, hear me, and entreat for me to Ephron the son of Zohar, ⁹that he may sell me the cave of Machpelah, which he has, which is in the end of his field. For the full price let him sell it to me among you as a possession for a burial place." ¹⁰Now Ephron was sitting in the middle of the children of Heth. Ephron the Hittite answered Abraham in the hearing of the children of Heth, even of all who went in at the gate of his city, saying, ¹¹"No, my lord, hear me. I give you the field, and I give you the cave that is in it. In the presence of the children of my people I give it to you. Bury your dead." ¹²Abraham bowed himself down before the people of the land. ¹³He spoke to Ephron in the audience of the people of the land, saying, "But if you will, please hear me. I will give the price of the field. Take it from me, and I will bury my dead there." ¹⁴Ephron answered Abraham, saying to him, ¹⁵"My lord, listen to me. What is a piece of land worth four hundred shekels of silver ^{xxiii} between me and you? Therefore bury your dead." ¹⁶Abraham listened to Ephron. Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver which he had named in the hearing of the children of Heth, four hundred shekels of silver, according to the current merchants' standard. ¹⁷So the field of Ephron, which was in Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the field, the cave which was in it, and all the trees that were in the field, that were in all of its borders, were deeded ¹⁸to Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all who went in at the gate of his city. ¹⁹After this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah before Mamre (that is, Hebron), in the land of Canaan. ²⁰The field, and the cave that is in it, were deeded to Abraham by the children of Heth as a possession for a burial place.

^{xxiii}A shekel is about 10 grams, so 400 shekels would be about 4 kg. or 8.8 pounds.

²⁴Abraham was old, and well advanced in age. The LORD had blessed Abraham in all things. ²Abraham said to his servant, the elder of his house, who ruled over all that he had, "Please put your hand under my thigh. ³I will make you swear by the LORD, the God of heaven and the God of the earth, that you shall not take a wife for my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I live. ⁴But you shall go to my country, and to my relatives, and take a wife for my son Isaac." ⁵The servant said to him, "What if the woman isn't willing to follow me to this land? Must I bring your son again to the land you came from?" ⁶Abraham said to him, "Beware that you don't bring my son there again. ⁷The LORD, the God of heaven—who took me from my father's house, and from the land of my birth, who spoke to me, and who swore to me, saying, 'I will give this land to your offspring—he will send his angel before you, and you shall take a wife for my son from there. ⁸If the woman isn't willing to follow you, then you shall be clear from this oath to me. Only you shall not bring my son there again.'" ⁹The servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham his master, and swore to him concerning this matter. ¹⁰The servant took ten of his master's camels, and departed, having a variety of good things of his master's with him. He arose, and went to Mesopotamia, to the city of Nahor. ¹¹He made the camels kneel down outside the city by the well of water at the time of evening, the time that women go out to draw water. ¹²He said, "LORD, the God of my master Abraham, please give me success today, and show kindness to my master Abraham. ¹³Behold, I am standing by the spring of water. The daughters of the men of the city are coming out to draw water. ¹⁴Let it happen, that the young lady to whom I will say, 'Please let down your pitcher, that I may drink,' then she says, 'Drink, and I will also give your camels a drink,'—let her be the one you have appointed for your servant Isaac. By this I will know that you have shown kindness to my master." ¹⁵Before he had finished speaking, behold, Rebekah came out, who was born to Bethuel the son of Milcah, the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, with her pitcher on her shoulder. ¹⁶The young lady was very beautiful to look at, a virgin. No man had known her. She went down to the spring, filled her pitcher, and came up. ¹⁷The servant ran to meet her, and said, "Please give me a drink, a little water from your pitcher." ¹⁸She said, "Drink, my lord." She hurried, and let down her pitcher on her hand, and gave him a drink. ¹⁹When she had finished giving him a drink, she said, "I will also draw for your camels, until they have finished drinking." ²⁰She hurried, and emptied her pitcher into the trough, and ran again to the well to draw, and drew for all his camels. ²¹The man looked steadfastly at her, remaining silent, to know whether the LORD had made his journey prosperous or not. ²²As the camels had done drinking, the

man took a golden ring of half a shekel ^{xxiv} weight, and two bracelets for her hands of ten shekels weight of gold, ²³and said, “Whose daughter are you? Please tell me. Is there room in your father’s house for us to stay?” ²⁴She said to him, “I am the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah, whom she bore to Nahor.” ²⁵She said moreover to him, “We have both straw and feed enough, and room to lodge in.” ²⁶The man bowed his head, and worshiped the LORD. ²⁷He said, “Blessed be the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who has not forsaken his loving kindness and his truth toward my master. As for me, the LORD has led me on the way to the house of my master’s relatives.” ²⁸The young lady ran, and told her mother’s house about these words. ²⁹Rebekah had a brother, and his name was Laban. Laban ran out to the man, to the spring. ³⁰When he saw the ring, and the bracelets on his sister’s hands, and when he heard the words of Rebekah his sister, saying, “This is what the man said to me,” he came to the man. Behold, he was standing by the camels at the spring. ³¹He said, “Come in, you blessed of the LORD. Why do you stand outside? For I have prepared the house, and room for the camels.” ³²The man came into the house, and he unloaded the camels. He gave straw and feed for the camels, and water to wash his feet and the feet of the men who were with him. ³³Food was set before him to eat, but he said, “I will not eat until I have told my message.” Laban said, “Speak on.” ³⁴He said, “I am Abraham’s servant. ³⁵The LORD has blessed my master greatly. He has become great. The LORD has given him flocks and herds, silver and gold, male servants and female servants, and camels and donkeys. ³⁶Sarah, my master’s wife, bore a son to my master when she was old. He has given all that he has to him. ³⁷My master made me swear, saying, ‘You shall not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I live, ³⁸but you shall go to my father’s house, and to my relatives, and take a wife for my son.’ ³⁹I asked my master, ‘What if the woman will not follow me?’ ⁴⁰He said to me, ‘The LORD, before whom I walk, will send his angel with you, and prosper your way. You shall take a wife for my son from my relatives, and of my father’s house. ⁴¹Then you will be clear from my oath, when you come to my relatives. If they don’t give her to you, you shall be clear from my oath.’ ⁴²I came today to the spring, and said, ‘The LORD, the God of my master Abraham, if now you do prosper my way which I go— ⁴³behold, I am standing by this spring of water. Let it happen, that the maiden who comes out to draw, to whom I will say, ‘Please give me a little water from your pitcher to drink,’ ⁴⁴then she tells me, ‘Drink, and I will also draw for your camels,’—let her be the woman whom the LORD has appointed for my master’s son.’ ⁴⁵Before I had finished speaking in my heart, behold, Rebekah came out with her pitcher on her shoulder. She went down to

the spring, and drew. I said to her, ‘Please let me drink.’ ⁴⁶She hurried and let down her pitcher from her shoulder, and said, ‘Drink, and I will also give your camels a drink.’ So I drank, and she also gave the camels a drink. ⁴⁷I asked her, and said, ‘Whose daughter are you?’ She said, ‘The daughter of Bethuel, Nahor’s son, whom Milcah bore to him.’ I put the ring on her nose, and the bracelets on her hands. ⁴⁸I bowed my head, and worshiped the LORD, and blessed the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who had led me in the right way to take my master’s brother’s daughter for his son. ⁴⁹Now if you will deal kindly and truly with my master, tell me. If not, tell me, that I may turn to the right hand, or to the left.” ⁵⁰Then Laban and Bethuel answered, “The thing proceeds from the LORD. We can’t speak to you bad or good. ⁵¹Behold, Rebekah is before you. Take her, and go, and let her be your master’s son’s wife, as the LORD has spoken.” ⁵²When Abraham’s servant heard their words, he bowed himself down to the earth to the LORD. ⁵³The servant brought out jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and clothing, and gave them to Rebekah. He also gave precious things to her brother and her mother. ⁵⁴They ate and drank, he and the men who were with him, and stayed all night. They rose up in the morning, and he said, “Send me away to my master.” ⁵⁵Her brother and her mother said, “Let the young lady stay with us a few days, at least ten. After that she will go.” ⁵⁶He said to them, “Don’t hinder me, since the LORD has prospered my way. Send me away that I may go to my master.” ⁵⁷They said, “We will call the young lady, and ask her.” ⁵⁸They called Rebekah, and said to her, “Will you go with this man?” She said, “I will go.” ⁵⁹They sent away Rebekah, their sister, with her nurse, Abraham’s servant, and his men. ⁶⁰They blessed Rebekah, and said to her, “Our sister, may you be the mother of thousands of ten thousands, and let your offspring possess the gate of those who hate them.” ⁶¹Rebekah arose with her ladies. They rode on the camels, and followed the man. The servant took Rebekah, and went his way. ⁶²Isaac came from the way of Beer Lahai Roi, for he lived in the land of the South. ⁶³Isaac went out to meditate in the field at the evening. He lifted up his eyes and looked. Behold, there were camels coming. ⁶⁴Rebekah lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she got off the camel. ⁶⁵She said to the servant, “Who is the man who is walking in the field to meet us?” The servant said, “It is my master.” She took her veil, and covered herself. ⁶⁶The servant told Isaac all the things that he had done. ⁶⁷Isaac brought her into his mother Sarah’s tent, and took Rebekah, and she became his wife. He loved her. So Isaac was comforted after his mother’s death.

25 Abraham took another wife, and her name was Keturah. ²She bore him Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. ³Jokshan became the father of Sheba,

^{xxiv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

and Dedan. The sons of Dedan were Asshurim, Letushim, and Leummim. ⁴The sons of Midian were Ephah, Ephraim, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the children of Keturah. ⁵Abraham gave all that he had to Isaac, ⁶but Abraham gave gifts to the sons of Abraham's concubines. While he still lived, he sent them away from Isaac his son, eastward, to the east country. ⁷These are the days of the years of Abraham's life which he lived: one hundred seventy-five years. ⁸Abraham gave up his spirit, and died at a good old age, an old man, and full of years, and was gathered to his people. ⁹Isaac and Ishmael, his sons, buried him in the cave of Machpelah, in the field of Ephron, the son of Zohar the Hittite, which is near Mamre, ¹⁰the field which Abraham purchased from the children of Heth. Abraham was buried there with Sarah, his wife. ¹¹After the death of Abraham, God blessed Isaac, his son. Isaac lived by Beer Lahai Roi. ¹²Now this is the history of the generations of Ishmael, Abraham's son, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's servant, bore to Abraham. ¹³These are the names of the sons of Ishmael, by their names, according to the order of their birth: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebaioth, then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, ¹⁴Mishma, Dumah, Massa, ¹⁵Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah. ¹⁶These are the sons of Ishmael, and these are their names, by their villages, and by their encampments: twelve princes, according to their nations. ¹⁷These are the years of the life of Ishmael: one hundred thirty-seven years. He gave up his spirit and died, and was gathered to his people. ¹⁸They lived from Havilah to Shur that is before Egypt, as you go toward Assyria. He lived opposite all his relatives. ¹⁹This is the history of the generations of Isaac, Abraham's son. Abraham became the father of Isaac. ²⁰Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekah, the daughter of Bethuel the Syrian of Paddan Aram, the sister of Laban the Syrian, to be his wife. ²¹Isaac entreated the LORD for his wife, because she was barren. The LORD was entreated by him, and Rebekah his wife conceived. ²²The children struggled together within her. She said, "If it is like this, why do I live?" She went to inquire of the LORD. ²³The LORD said to her, "Two nations are in your womb. Two peoples will be separated from your body. The one people will be stronger than the other people. The elder will serve the younger." ²⁴When her days to be delivered were fulfilled, behold, there were twins in her womb. ²⁵The first came out red all over, like a hairy garment. They named him Esau. ²⁶After that, his brother came out, and his hand had hold on Esau's heel. He was named Jacob. Isaac was sixty years old when she bore them. ²⁷The boys grew. Esau was a skillful hunter, a man of the field. Jacob was a quiet man, living in tents. ²⁸Now Isaac loved Esau, because he ate his venison. Rebekah loved Jacob. ²⁹Jacob boiled stew. Esau came in from the field, and he was famished. ³⁰Esau said to Jacob, "Please feed me with some of that red stew, for

I am famished." Therefore his name was called Edom. ^{xxv}
³¹Jacob said, "First, sell me your birthright." ³²Esau said, "Behold, I am about to die. What good is the birthright to me?" ³³Jacob said, "Swear to me first." He swore to him. He sold his birthright to Jacob. ³⁴Jacob gave Esau bread and lentil stew. He ate and drank, rose up, and went his way. So Esau despised his birthright.

26There was a famine in the land, in addition to the first famine that was in the days of Abraham. Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Philistines, to Gerar. ²The LORD appeared to him, and said, "Don't go down into Egypt. Live in the land I will tell you about. ³Live in this land, and I will be with you, and will bless you. For I will give to you, and to your offspring, all these lands, and I will establish the oath which I swore to Abraham your father. ⁴I will multiply your offspring as the stars of the sky, and will give all these lands to your offspring. In your offspring all the nations of the earth will be blessed, ⁵because Abraham obeyed my voice, and kept my requirements, my commandments, my statutes, and my laws." ⁶Isaac lived in Gerar. ⁷The men of the place asked him about his wife. He said, "She is my sister," for he was afraid to say, "My wife", lest, he thought, "the men of the place might kill me for Rebekah, because she is beautiful to look at." ⁸When he had been there a long time, Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out at a window, and saw, and, behold, Isaac was caressing Rebekah, his wife. ⁹Abimelech called Isaac, and said, "Behold, surely she is your wife. Why did you say, 'She is my sister?'" Isaac said to him, "Because I said, 'Lest I die because of her.'" ¹⁰Abimelech said, "What is this you have done to us? One of the people might easily have lain with your wife, and you would have brought guilt on us!" ¹¹Abimelech commanded all the people, saying, "He who touches this man or his wife will surely be put to death." ¹²Isaac sowed in that land, and reaped in the same year one hundred times what he planted. The LORD blessed him. ¹³The man grew great, and grew more and more until he became very great. ¹⁴He had possessions of flocks, possessions of herds, and a great household. The Philistines envied him. ¹⁵Now all the wells which his father's servants had dug in the days of Abraham his father, the Philistines had stopped, and filled with earth. ¹⁶Abimelech said to Isaac, "Go away from us, for you are much mightier than we." ¹⁷Isaac departed from there, encamped in the valley of Gerar, and lived there. ¹⁸Isaac dug again the wells of water, which they had dug in the days of Abraham his father, for the Philistines had stopped them after the death of Abraham. He called their names after the names by which his father had called them. ¹⁹Isaac's servants dug in the valley, and found there a well of flowing ^{xxvi} water. ²⁰The herdsmen of Gerar argued with Isaac's herdsmen,

^{xxv}"Edom" means "red".

^{xxvi}Or, living. Or, fresh.

saying, “The water is ours.” So he called the name of the well Esek, ^{xxvii} because they contended with him. ²¹They dug another well, and they argued over that, also. So he called its name Sitnah. ^{xxviii} ²²He left that place, and dug another well. They didn’t argue over that one. So he called it Rehoboth. ^{xxix} He said, “For now the LORD has made room for us, and we will be fruitful in the land.” ²³He went up from there to Beersheba. ²⁴The LORD appeared to him the same night, and said, “I am the God of Abraham your father. Don’t be afraid, for I am with you, and will bless you, and multiply your offspring for my servant Abraham’s sake.” ²⁵He built an altar there, and called on the LORD’s name, and pitched his tent there. There Isaac’s servants dug a well. ²⁶Then Abimelech went to him from Gerar with Ahuzzath his friend, and Phicol the captain of his army. ²⁷Isaac said to them, “Why have you come to me, since you hate me, and have sent me away from you?” ²⁸They said, “We saw plainly that the LORD was with you. We said, ‘Let there now be an oath between us, even between us and you, and let’s make a covenant with you, ²⁹that you will do us no harm, as we have not touched you, and as we have done to you nothing but good, and have sent you away in peace.’ You are now the blessed of the LORD.” ³⁰He made them a feast, and they ate and drank. ³¹They rose up some time in the morning, and swore an oath to one another. Isaac sent them away, and they departed from him in peace. ³²The same day, Isaac’s servants came, and told him concerning the well which they had dug, and said to him, “We have found water.” ³³He called it “Shibah”. ^{xxx} Therefore the name of the city is “Beersheba” ^{xxxi} to this day. ³⁴When Esau was forty years old, he took as wife Judith, the daughter of Beeri the Hittite, and Basemath, the daughter of Elon the Hittite. ³⁵They grieved Isaac’s and Rebekah’s spirits.

27 When Isaac was old, and his eyes were dim, so that he could not see, he called Esau his elder son, and said to him, “My son?” He said to him, “Here I am.” ²He said, “See now, I am old. I don’t know the day of my death. ³Now therefore, please take your weapons, your quiver and your bow, and go out to the field, and get me venison. ⁴Make me savory food, such as I love, and bring it to me, that I may eat, and that my soul may bless you before I die.” ⁵Rebekah heard when Isaac spoke to Esau his son. Esau went to the field to hunt for venison, and to bring it. ⁶Rebekah spoke to Jacob her son, saying, “Behold, I heard your father speak to Esau your brother, saying, ⁷‘Bring me venison, and make me savory food, that I may eat, and bless you before the LORD before my death.’ ⁸Now

therefore, my son, obey my voice according to that which I command you. ⁹Go now to the flock and get me two good young goats from there. I will make them savory food for your father, such as he loves. ¹⁰You shall bring it to your father, that he may eat, so that he may bless you before his death.” ¹¹Jacob said to Rebekah his mother, “Behold, Esau my brother is a hairy man, and I am a smooth man. ¹²What if my father touches me? I will seem to him as a deceiver, and I would bring a curse on myself, and not a blessing.” ¹³His mother said to him, “Let your curse be on me, my son. Only obey my voice, and go get them for me.” ¹⁴He went, and got them, and brought them to his mother. His mother made savory food, such as his father loved. ¹⁵Rebekah took the good clothes of Esau, her elder son, which were with her in the house, and put them on Jacob, her younger son. ¹⁶She put the skins of the young goats on his hands, and on the smooth of his neck. ¹⁷She gave the savory food and the bread, which she had prepared, into the hand of her son Jacob. ¹⁸He came to his father, and said, “My father?” He said, “Here I am. Who are you, my son?” ¹⁹Jacob said to his father, “I am Esau your firstborn. I have done what you asked me to do. Please arise, sit and eat of my venison, that your soul may bless me.” ²⁰Isaac said to his son, “How is it that you have found it so quickly, my son?” He said, “Because the LORD your God gave me success.” ²¹Isaac said to Jacob, “Please come near, that I may feel you, my son, whether you are really my son Esau or not.” ²²Jacob went near to Isaac his father. He felt him, and said, “The voice is Jacob’s voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau.” ²³He didn’t recognize him, because his hands were hairy, like his brother Esau’s hands. So he blessed him. ²⁴He said, “Are you really my son Esau?” He said, “I am.” ²⁵He said, “Bring it near to me, and I will eat of my son’s venison, that my soul may bless you.” He brought it near to him, and he ate. He brought him wine, and he drank. ²⁶His father Isaac said to him, “Come near now, and kiss me, my son.” ²⁷He came near, and kissed him. He smelled the smell of his clothing, and blessed him, and said, “Behold, the smell of my son is as the smell of a field which the LORD has blessed. ²⁸God give you of the dew of the sky, of the fatness of the earth, and plenty of grain and new wine. ²⁹Let peoples serve you, and nations bow down to you. Be lord over your brothers. Let your mother’s sons bow down to you. Cursed be everyone who curses you. Blessed be everyone who blesses you.” ³⁰As soon as Isaac had finished blessing Jacob, and Jacob had just gone out from the presence of Isaac his father, Esau his brother came in from his hunting. ³¹He also made savory food, and brought it to his father. He said to his father, “Let my father arise, and eat of his son’s venison, that your soul may bless me.” ³²Isaac his father said to him, “Who are you?” He said, “I am your son, your firstborn, Esau.” ³³Isaac trembled violently, and said, “Who, then, is he who has taken venison, and brought it to me, and I

^{xxvii}“Esek” means “contention”.

^{xxviii}“Sitnah” means “hostility”.

^{xxix}“Rehoboth” means “broad places”.

^{xxx}Shibah means “oath” or “seven”.

^{xxxi}Beersheba means “well of the oath” or “well of the seven”

have eaten of all before you came, and have blessed him? Yes, he will be blessed.”³⁴ When Esau heard the words of his father, he cried with an exceedingly great and bitter cry, and said to his father, “Bless me, even me also, my father.”³⁵ He said, “Your brother came with deceit, and has taken away your blessing.”³⁶ He said, “Isn’t he rightly named Jacob? For he has supplanted me these two times. He took away my birthright. See, now he has taken away my blessing.” He said, “Haven’t you reserved a blessing for me?”³⁷ Isaac answered Esau, “Behold, I have made him your lord, and all his brothers I have given to him for servants. I have sustained him with grain and new wine. What then will I do for you, my son?”³⁸ Esau said to his father, “Do you have just one blessing, my father? Bless me, even me also, my father.” Esau lifted up his voice, and wept.³⁹ Isaac his father answered him, “Behold, your dwelling will be of the fatness of the earth, and of the dew of the sky from above.”⁴⁰ You will live by your sword, and you will serve your brother. It will happen, when you will break loose, that you will shake his yoke from off your neck.”⁴¹ Esau hated Jacob because of the blessing with which his father blessed him. Esau said in his heart, “The days of mourning for my father are at hand. Then I will kill my brother Jacob.”⁴² The words of Esau, her elder son, were told to Rebekah. She sent and called Jacob, her younger son, and said to him, “Behold, your brother Esau comforts himself about you by planning to kill you.”⁴³ Now therefore, my son, obey my voice. Arise, flee to Laban, my brother, in Haran.⁴⁴ Stay with him a few days, until your brother’s fury turns away—⁴⁵until your brother’s anger turns away from you, and he forgets what you have done to him. Then I will send, and get you from there. Why should I be bereaved of you both in one day?”⁴⁶ Rebekah said to Isaac, “I am weary of my life because of the daughters of Heth. If Jacob takes a wife of the daughters of Heth, such as these, of the daughters of the land, what good will my life do me?”

28 Isaac called Jacob, blessed him, and commanded him, “You shall not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan.”² Arise, go to Paddan Aram, to the house of Bethuel your mother’s father. Take a wife from there from the daughters of Laban, your mother’s brother.³ May God Almighty bless you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, that you may be a company of peoples,⁴ and give you the blessing of Abraham, to you and to your offspring with you, that you may inherit the land where you travel, which God gave to Abraham.”⁵ Isaac sent Jacob away. He went to Paddan Aram to Laban, son of Bethuel the Syrian, the brother of Rebekah, Jacob’s and Esau’s mother.⁶ Now Esau saw that Isaac had blessed Jacob and sent him away to Paddan Aram, to take him a wife from there, and that as he blessed him he gave him a command, saying, “You shall not take a wife of the daughters of Canaan;”⁷ and that

Jacob obeyed his father and his mother, and was gone to Paddan Aram.⁸ Esau saw that the daughters of Canaan didn’t please Isaac, his father.⁹ So Esau went to Ishmael, and took, in addition to the wives that he had, Mahalath the daughter of Ishmael, Abraham’s son, the sister of Nebaioth, to be his wife.¹⁰ Jacob went out from Beersheba, and went toward Haran.¹¹ He came to a certain place, and stayed there all night, because the sun had set. He took one of the stones of the place, and put it under his head, and lay down in that place to sleep.¹² He dreamed and saw a stairway set upon the earth, and its top reached to heaven. Behold, the angels of God were ascending and descending on it.¹³ Behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, “I am the LORD, the God of Abraham your father, and the God of Isaac. I will give the land you lie on to you and to your offspring.”¹⁴ Your offspring will be as the dust of the earth, and you will spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south. In you and in your offspring, all the families of the earth will be blessed.¹⁵ Behold, I am with you, and will keep you, wherever you go, and will bring you again into this land. For I will not leave you until I have done that which I have spoken of to you.”¹⁶ Jacob awakened out of his sleep, and he said, “Surely the LORD is in this place, and I didn’t know it.”¹⁷ He was afraid, and said, “How awesome this place is! This is none other than God’s house, and this is the gate of heaven.”¹⁸ Jacob rose up early in the morning, and took the stone that he had put under his head, and set it up for a pillar, and poured oil on its top.¹⁹ He called the name of that place Bethel, but the name of the city was Luz at the first.²⁰ Jacob vowed a vow, saying, “If God will be with me, and will keep me in this way that I go, and will give me bread to eat, and clothing to put on,²¹ so that I come again to my father’s house in peace, and the LORD will be my God,²² then this stone, which I have set up for a pillar, will be God’s house. Of all that you will give me I will surely give a tenth to you.”

29 Then Jacob went on his journey, and came to the land of the children of the east.² He looked, and saw a well in the field, and saw three flocks of sheep lying there by it. For out of that well they watered the flocks. The stone on the well’s mouth was large.³ There all the flocks were gathered. They rolled the stone from the well’s mouth, and watered the sheep, and put the stone back on the well’s mouth in its place.⁴ Jacob said to them, “My relatives, where are you from?” They said, “We are from Haran.”⁵ He said to them, “Do you know Laban, the son of Nahor?” They said, “We know him.”⁶ He said to them, “Is it well with him?” They said, “It is well. See, Rachel, his daughter, is coming with the sheep.”⁷ He said, “Behold, it is still the middle of the day, not time to gather the livestock together. Water the sheep, and go and feed them.”⁸ They said, “We can’t, until all the flocks are gathered

together, and they roll the stone from the well's mouth. Then we will water the sheep." ⁹While he was yet speaking with them, Rachel came with her father's sheep, for she kept them. ¹⁰When Jacob saw Rachel the daughter of Laban, his mother's brother, and the sheep of Laban, his mother's brother, Jacob went near, and rolled the stone from the well's mouth, and watered the flock of Laban his mother's brother. ¹¹Jacob kissed Rachel, and lifted up his voice, and wept. ¹²Jacob told Rachel that he was her father's relative, and that he was Rebekah's son. She ran and told her father. ¹³When Laban heard the news of Jacob, his sister's son, he ran to meet Jacob, and embraced him, and kissed him, and brought him to his house. Jacob told Laban all these things. ¹⁴Laban said to him, "Surely you are my bone and my flesh." Jacob stayed with him for a month. ¹⁵Laban said to Jacob, "Because you are my relative, should you therefore serve me for nothing? Tell me, what will your wages be?" ¹⁶Laban had two daughters. The name of the elder was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel. ¹⁷Leah's eyes were weak, but Rachel was beautiful in form and attractive. ¹⁸Jacob loved Rachel. He said, "I will serve you seven years for Rachel, your younger daughter." ¹⁹Laban said, "It is better that I give her to you, than that I should give her to another man. Stay with me." ²⁰Jacob served seven years for Rachel. They seemed to him but a few days, for the love he had for her. ²¹Jacob said to Laban, "Give me my wife, for my days are fulfilled, that I may go in to her." ²²Laban gathered together all the men of the place, and made a feast. ²³In the evening, he took Leah his daughter, and brought her to Jacob. He went in to her. ²⁴Laban gave Zilpah his servant to his daughter Leah for a servant. ²⁵In the morning, behold, it was Leah! He said to Laban, "What is this you have done to me? Didn't I serve with you for Rachel? Why then have you deceived me?" ²⁶Laban said, "It is not done so in our place, to give the younger before the firstborn. ²⁷Fulfill the week of this one, and we will give you the other also for the service which you will serve with me for seven more years." ²⁸Jacob did so, and fulfilled her week. He gave him Rachel his daughter as wife. ²⁹Laban gave Bilhah, his servant, to his daughter Rachel to be her servant. ³⁰He went in also to Rachel, and he loved also Rachel more than Leah, and served with him seven more years. ³¹The LORD saw that Leah was hated, and he opened her womb, but Rachel was barren. ³²Leah conceived, and bore a son, and she named him Reuben. For she said, "Because the LORD has looked at my affliction; for now my husband will love me." ³³She conceived again, and bore a son, and said, "Because the LORD has heard that I am hated, he has therefore given me this son also." She named him Simeon. ³⁴She conceived again, and bore a son. She said, "Now this time my husband will be joined to me, because I have borne him three sons." Therefore his name was called Levi. ³⁵She conceived again, and

bore a son. She said, "This time I will praise the LORD." Therefore she named him Judah. Then she stopped bearing.

30When Rachel saw that she bore Jacob no children, Rachel envied her sister. She said to Jacob, "Give me children, or else I will die." ²Jacob's anger burned against Rachel, and he said, "Am I in God's place, who has withheld from you the fruit of the womb?" ³She said, "Behold, my maid Bilhah. Go in to her, that she may bear on my knees, and I also may obtain children by her." ⁴She gave him Bilhah her servant as wife, and Jacob went in to her. ⁵Bilhah conceived, and bore Jacob a son. ⁶Rachel said, "God has judged me, and has also heard my voice, and has given me a son." Therefore she called his name Dan. ⁷Bilhah, Rachel's servant, conceived again, and bore Jacob a second son. ⁸Rachel said, "I have wrestled with my sister with mighty wrestlings, and have prevailed." She named him Naphtali. ⁹When Leah saw that she had finished bearing, she took Zilpah, her servant, and gave her to Jacob as a wife. ¹⁰Zilpah, Leah's servant, bore Jacob a son. ¹¹Leah said, "How fortunate!" She named him Gad. ¹²Zilpah, Leah's servant, bore Jacob a second son. ¹³Leah said, "Happy am I, for the daughters will call me happy." She named him Asher. ¹⁴Reuben went in the days of wheat harvest, and found mandrakes in the field, and brought them to his mother, Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, "Please give me some of your son's mandrakes." ¹⁵Leah said to her, "Is it a small matter that you have taken away my husband? Would you take away my son's mandrakes, also?" Rachel said, "Therefore he will lie with you tonight for your son's mandrakes." ¹⁶Jacob came from the field in the evening, and Leah went out to meet him, and said, "You must come in to me; for I have surely hired you with my son's mandrakes." He lay with her that night. ¹⁷God listened to Leah, and she conceived, and bore Jacob a fifth son. ¹⁸Leah said, "God has given me my hire, because I gave my servant to my husband." She named him Issachar. ¹⁹Leah conceived again, and bore a sixth son to Jacob. ²⁰Leah said, "God has endowed me with a good dowry. Now my husband will live with me, because I have borne him six sons." She named him Zebulun. ²¹Afterwards, she bore a daughter, and named her Dinah. ²²God remembered Rachel, and God listened to her, and opened her womb. ²³She conceived, bore a son, and said, "God has taken away my reproach." ²⁴She named him Joseph, ^{xxxii}saying, "May the LORD add another son to me." ²⁵When Rachel had borne Joseph, Jacob said to Laban, "Send me away, that I may go to my own place, and to my country. ²⁶Give me my wives and my children for whom I have served you, and let me go; for you know my service with which I have served you." ²⁷Laban said to him, "If now I have found favor in your eyes, stay here,

^{xxxii}Joseph means "may he add".

for I have divined that the LORD has blessed me for your sake.”²⁸ He said, “Appoint me your wages, and I will give it.”²⁹ Jacob said to him, “You know how I have served you, and how your livestock have fared with me.”³⁰ For it was little which you had before I came, and it has increased to a multitude. The LORD has blessed you wherever I turned. Now when will I provide for my own house also?”³¹ Laban said, “What shall I give you?” Jacob said, “You shall not give me anything. If you will do this thing for me, I will again feed your flock and keep it.”³² I will pass through all your flock today, removing from there every speckled and spotted one, and every black one among the sheep, and the spotted and speckled among the goats. This will be my hire.”³³ So my righteousness will answer for me hereafter, when you come concerning my hire that is before you. Every one that is not speckled and spotted among the goats, and black among the sheep, that might be with me, will be considered stolen.”³⁴ Laban said, “Behold, let it be according to your word.”³⁵ That day, he removed the male goats that were streaked and spotted, and all the female goats that were speckled and spotted, every one that had white in it, and all the black ones among the sheep, and gave them into the hand of his sons.”³⁶ He set three days’ journey between himself and Jacob, and Jacob fed the rest of Laban’s flocks.”³⁷ Jacob took to himself rods of fresh poplar, almond, and plane tree, peeled white streaks in them, and made the white appear which was in the rods.”³⁸ He set the rods which he had peeled opposite the flocks in the watering troughs where the flocks came to drink. They conceived when they came to drink.”³⁹ The flocks conceived before the rods, and the flocks produced streaked, speckled, and spotted.”⁴⁰ Jacob separated the lambs, and set the faces of the flocks toward the streaked and all the black in Laban’s flock. He put his own droves apart, and didn’t put them into Laban’s flock.”⁴¹ Whenever the stronger of the flock conceived, Jacob laid the rods in front of the eyes of the flock in the watering troughs, that they might conceive among the rods;⁴² but when the flock were feeble, he didn’t put them in. So the feebler were Laban’s, and the stronger Jacob’s.”⁴³ The man increased exceedingly, and had large flocks, female servants and male servants, and camels and donkeys.

31 Jacob heard Laban’s sons’ words, saying, “Jacob has taken away all that was our father’s. He has obtained all this wealth from that which was our father’s.”² Jacob saw the expression on Laban’s face, and, behold, it was not toward him as before.”³ The LORD said to Jacob, “Return to the land of your fathers, and to your relatives, and I will be with you.”⁴ Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah to the field to his flock,⁵ and said to them, “I see the expression on your father’s face, that it is not toward me as before; but the God of my father has been with me.”⁶ You know that I have served your father with all of my

strength.”⁷ Your father has deceived me, and changed my wages ten times, but God didn’t allow him to hurt me.”⁸ If he said, ‘The speckled will be your wages,’ then all the flock bore speckled. If he said, ‘The streaked will be your wages,’ then all the flock bore streaked.”⁹ Thus God has taken away your father’s livestock, and given them to me.”¹⁰ During mating season, I lifted up my eyes, and saw in a dream, and behold, the male goats which leaped on the flock were streaked, speckled, and grizzled.”¹¹ The angel of God said to me in the dream, ‘Jacob,’ and I said, ‘Here I am.’¹² He said, ‘Now lift up your eyes, and behold, all the male goats which leap on the flock are streaked, speckled, and grizzled, for I have seen all that Laban does to you.’¹³ I am the God of Bethel, where you anointed a pillar, where you vowed a vow to me. Now arise, get out from this land, and return to the land of your birth.”¹⁴ Rachel and Leah answered him, “Is there yet any portion or inheritance for us in our father’s house?”¹⁵ Aren’t we considered as foreigners by him? For he has sold us, and has also used up our money.”¹⁶ For all the riches which God has taken away from our father are ours and our children’s. Now then, whatever God has said to you, do.”¹⁷ Then Jacob rose up, and set his sons and his wives on the camels,¹⁸ and he took away all his livestock, and all his possessions which he had gathered, including the livestock which he had gained in Paddan Aram, to go to Isaac his father, to the land of Canaan.”¹⁹ Now Laban had gone to shear his sheep; and Rachel stole the teraphim^{xxxiii} that were her father’s.”²⁰ Jacob deceived Laban the Syrian, in that he didn’t tell him that he was running away.”²¹ So he fled with all that he had. He rose up, passed over the River, and set his face toward the mountain of Gilead.”²² Laban was told on the third day that Jacob had fled.”²³ He took his relatives with him, and pursued him seven days’ journey. He overtook him in the mountain of Gilead.”²⁴ God came to Laban the Syrian in a dream of the night, and said to him, “Be careful that you don’t speak to Jacob either good or bad.”²⁵ Laban caught up with Jacob. Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the mountain, and Laban with his relatives encamped in the mountain of Gilead.”²⁶ Laban said to Jacob, “What have you done, that you have deceived me, and carried away my daughters like captives of the sword?”²⁷ Why did you flee secretly, and deceive me, and didn’t tell me, that I might have sent you away with mirth and with songs, with tambourine and with harp; ²⁸and didn’t allow me to kiss my sons and my daughters? Now have you done foolishly.”²⁹ It is in the power of my hand to hurt you, but the God of your father spoke to me last night, saying, ‘Be careful that you don’t speak to Jacob either good or bad.’³⁰ Now, you want to be gone, because you greatly longed for your father’s house, but why have you stolen my gods?”³¹ Jacob answered Laban, “Because I

^{xxxiii}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

was afraid, for I said, ‘Lest you should take your daughters from me by force.’³² Anyone you find your gods with shall not live. Before our relatives, discern what is yours with me, and take it.” For Jacob didn’t know that Rachel had stolen them.³³ Laban went into Jacob’s tent, into Leah’s tent, and into the tent of the two female servants; but he didn’t find them. He went out of Leah’s tent, and entered into Rachel’s tent.³⁴ Now Rachel had taken the teraphim, put them in the camel’s saddle, and sat on them. Laban felt around all the tent, but didn’t find them.³⁵ She said to her father, “Don’t let my lord be angry that I can’t rise up before you; for I’m having my period.” He searched, but didn’t find the teraphim.³⁶ Jacob was angry, and argued with Laban. Jacob answered Laban, “What is my trespass? What is my sin, that you have hotly pursued me?”³⁷ Now that you have felt around in all my stuff, what have you found of all your household stuff? Set it here before my relatives and your relatives, that they may judge between us two.³⁸ “These twenty years I have been with you. Your ewes and your female goats have not cast their young, and I haven’t eaten the rams of your flocks.³⁹ That which was torn of animals, I didn’t bring to you. I bore its loss. Of my hand you required it, whether stolen by day or stolen by night.⁴⁰ This was my situation: in the day the drought consumed me, and the frost by night; and my sleep fled from my eyes.⁴¹ These twenty years I have been in your house. I served you fourteen years for your two daughters, and six years for your flock, and you have changed my wages ten times.⁴² Unless the God of my father, the God of Abraham, and the fear of Isaac, had been with me, surely now you would have sent me away empty. God has seen my affliction and the labor of my hands, and rebuked you last night.”⁴³ Laban answered Jacob, “The daughters are my daughters, the children are my children, the flocks are my flocks, and all that you see is mine! What can I do today to these my daughters, or to their children whom they have borne?”⁴⁴ Now come, let’s make a covenant, you and I. Let it be for a witness between me and you.”⁴⁵ Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a pillar.⁴⁶ Jacob said to his relatives, “Gather stones.” They took stones, and made a heap. They ate there by the heap.⁴⁷ Laban called it Jegar Sahadutha,^{xxxiv} but Jacob called it Galeed.^{xxxv}⁴⁸ Laban said, “This heap is witness between me and you today.” Therefore it was named Galeed⁴⁹ and Mizpah, for he said, “The LORD watch between me and you, when we are absent one from another.⁵⁰ If you afflict my daughters, or if you take wives in addition to my daughters, no man is with us; behold, God is witness between me and you.”⁵¹ Laban said to Jacob, “See this heap, and see the pillar, which I have set between me and you.⁵² May this heap be a witness, and the pillar be a witness, that I will not pass over this heap to you, and that you will not pass over

this heap and this pillar to me, for harm.⁵³ The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge between us.” Then Jacob swore by the fear of his father, Isaac.⁵⁴ Jacob offered a sacrifice in the mountain, and called his relatives to eat bread. They ate bread, and stayed all night in the mountain.⁵⁵ Early in the morning, Laban rose up, and kissed his sons and his daughters, and blessed them. Laban departed and returned to his place.

32 Jacob went on his way, and the angels of God met him.² When he saw them, Jacob said, “This is God’s army.” He called the name of that place Mahanaim.^{xxxvi}³ Jacob sent messengers in front of him to Esau, his brother, to the land of Seir, the field of Edom.⁴ He commanded them, saying, “This is what you shall tell my lord, Esau: ‘This is what your servant, Jacob, says. I have lived as a foreigner with Laban, and stayed until now.⁵ I have cattle, donkeys, flocks, male servants, and female servants. I have sent to tell my lord, that I may find favor in your sight.’”⁶ The messengers returned to Jacob, saying, “We came to your brother Esau. He is coming to meet you, and four hundred men are with him.”⁷ Then Jacob was greatly afraid and was distressed. He divided the people who were with him, along with the flocks, the herds, and the camels, into two companies.⁸ He said, “If Esau comes to the one company, and strikes it, then the company which is left will escape.”⁹ Jacob said, “God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac, the LORD, who said to me, ‘Return to your country, and to your relatives, and I will do you good,’¹⁰ I am not worthy of the least of all the loving kindnesses, and of all the truth, which you have shown to your servant; for with just my staff I crossed over this Jordan; and now I have become two companies.¹¹ Please deliver me from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau; for I fear him, lest he come and strike me and the mothers with the children.¹² You said, ‘I will surely do you good, and make your offspring as the sand of the sea, which can’t be counted because there are so many.’”¹³ He stayed there that night, and took from that which he had with him a present for Esau, his brother:¹⁴ two hundred female goats and twenty male goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,¹⁵ thirty milk camels and their colts, forty cows, ten bulls, twenty female donkeys and ten foals.¹⁶ He delivered them into the hands of his servants, every herd by itself, and said to his servants, “Pass over before me, and put a space between herd and herd.”¹⁷ He commanded the foremost, saying, “When Esau, my brother, meets you, and asks you, saying, ‘Whose are you? Where are you going? Whose are these before you?’”¹⁸ Then you shall say, ‘They are your servant, Jacob’s. It is a present sent to my lord, Esau. Behold, he also is behind us.’”¹⁹ He commanded also the second, and the third, and all that followed the herds, saying, “This is how you shall speak to

^{xxxiv}“Jegar Sahadutha” means “Witness Heap” in Aramaic.

^{xxxv}“Galeed” means “Witness Heap” in Hebrew.

^{xxxvi}“Mahanaim” means “two camps”.

Esau, when you find him. ²⁰You shall say, ‘Not only that, but behold, your servant, Jacob, is behind us.’” For, he said, “I will appease him with the present that goes before me, and afterward I will see his face. Perhaps he will accept me.” ²¹So the present passed over before him, and he himself stayed that night in the camp. ²²He rose up that night, and took his two wives, and his two servants, and his eleven sons, and crossed over the ford of the Jabbok. ²³He took them, and sent them over the stream, and sent over that which he had. ²⁴Jacob was left alone, and wrestled with a man there until the breaking of the day. ²⁵When he saw that he didn’t prevail against him, the man touched the hollow of his thigh, and the hollow of Jacob’s thigh was strained as he wrestled. ²⁶The man said, “Let me go, for the day breaks.” Jacob said, “I won’t let you go unless you bless me.” ²⁷He said to him, “What is your name?” He said, “Jacob.” ²⁸He said, “Your name will no longer be called Jacob, but Israel; for you have fought with God and with men, and have prevailed.” ²⁹Jacob asked him, “Please tell me your name.” He said, “Why is it that you ask what my name is?” So he blessed him there. ³⁰Jacob called the name of the place Peniel; ^{xxxvii} for he said, “I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.” ³¹The sun rose on him as he passed over Peniel, and he limped because of his thigh. ³²Therefore the children of Israel don’t eat the sinew of the hip, which is on the hollow of the thigh, to this day, because he touched the hollow of Jacob’s thigh in the sinew of the hip.

33 Jacob lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, Esau was coming, and with him four hundred men. He divided the children between Leah, Rachel, and the two servants. ²He put the servants and their children in front, Leah and her children after, and Rachel and Joseph at the rear. ³He himself passed over in front of them, and bowed himself to the ground seven times, until he came near to his brother. ⁴Esau ran to meet him, embraced him, fell on his neck, kissed him, and they wept. ⁵He lifted up his eyes, and saw the women and the children; and said, “Who are these with you?” He said, “The children whom God has graciously given your servant.” ⁶Then the servants came near with their children, and they bowed themselves. ⁷Leah also and her children came near, and bowed themselves. After them, Joseph came near with Rachel, and they bowed themselves. ⁸Esau said, “What do you mean by all this company which I met?” Jacob said, “To find favor in the sight of my lord.” ⁹Esau said, “I have enough, my brother; let that which you have be yours.” ¹⁰Jacob said, “Please, no, if I have now found favor in your sight, then receive my present at my hand, because I have seen your face, as one sees the face of God, and you were pleased with me. ¹¹Please take the gift that I brought to you, because God has dealt graciously with me,

^{xxxvii} Peniel means “face of God”.

and because I have enough.” He urged him, and he took it. ¹²Esau said, “Let’s take our journey, and let’s go, and I will go before you.” ¹³Jacob said to him, “My lord knows that the children are tender, and that the flocks and herds with me have their young, and if they overdrive them one day, all the flocks will die. ¹⁴Please let my lord pass over before his servant, and I will lead on gently, according to the pace of the livestock that are before me and according to the pace of the children, until I come to my lord to Seir.” ¹⁵Esau said, “Let me now leave with you some of the people who are with me.” He said, “Why? Let me find favor in the sight of my lord.” ¹⁶So Esau returned that day on his way to Seir. ¹⁷Jacob traveled to Succoth, built himself a house, and made shelters for his livestock. Therefore the name of the place is called Succoth. ^{xxxviii} ¹⁸Jacob came in peace to the city of Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan, when he came from Paddan Aram; and encamped before the city. ¹⁹He bought the parcel of ground where he had spread his tent, at the hand of the children of Hamor, Shechem’s father, for one hundred pieces of money. ²⁰He erected an altar there, and called it El Elohe Israel. ^{xxxix}

34 Dinah, the daughter of Leah, whom she bore to Jacob, went out to see the daughters of the land. ²Shechem the son of Hamor the Hivite, the prince of the land, saw her. He took her, lay with her, and humbled her. ³His soul joined to Dinah, the daughter of Jacob, and he loved the young lady, and spoke kindly to the young lady. ⁴Shechem spoke to his father, Hamor, saying, “Get me this young lady as a wife.” ⁵Now Jacob heard that he had defiled Dinah, his daughter; and his sons were with his livestock in the field. Jacob held his peace until they came. ⁶Hamor the father of Shechem went out to Jacob to talk with him. ⁷The sons of Jacob came in from the field when they heard it. The men were grieved, and they were very angry, because he had done folly in Israel in lying with Jacob’s daughter, a thing that ought not to be done. ⁸Hamor talked with them, saying, “The soul of my son, Shechem, longs for your daughter. Please give her to him as a wife. ⁹Make marriages with us. Give your daughters to us, and take our daughters for yourselves. ¹⁰You shall dwell with us, and the land will be before you. Live and trade in it, and get possessions in it.” ¹¹Shechem said to her father and to her brothers, “Let me find favor in your eyes, and whatever you will tell me I will give. ¹²Ask me a great amount for a dowry, and I will give whatever you ask of me, but give me the young lady as a wife.” ¹³The sons of Jacob answered Shechem and Hamor his father with deceit when they spoke, because he had defiled Dinah their sister, ¹⁴and said to them, “We can’t do this thing, to give our

^{xxxviii} succoth means shelters or booths.

^{xxxix} El Elohe Israel means “God, the God of Israel” or “The God of Israel is mighty”.

sister to one who is uncircumcised; for that is a reproach to us. ¹⁵Only on this condition will we consent to you. If you will be as we are, that every male of you be circumcised, ¹⁶then will we give our daughters to you; and we will take your daughters to us, and we will dwell with you, and we will become one people. ¹⁷But if you will not listen to us and be circumcised, then we will take our sister, ^{x1} and we will be gone.” ¹⁸Their words pleased Hamor and Shechem, Hamor’s son. ¹⁹The young man didn’t wait to do this thing, because he had delight in Jacob’s daughter, and he was honored above all the house of his father. ²⁰Hamor and Shechem, his son, came to the gate of their city, and talked with the men of their city, saying, ²¹“These men are peaceful with us. Therefore let them live in the land and trade in it. For behold, the land is large enough for them. Let’s take their daughters to us for wives, and let’s give them our daughters. ²²Only on this condition will the men consent to us to live with us, to become one people, if every male among us is circumcised, as they are circumcised. ²³Won’t their livestock and their possessions and all their animals be ours? Only let’s give our consent to them, and they will dwell with us.” ²⁴All who went out of the gate of his city listened to Hamor, and to Shechem his son; and every male was circumcised, all who went out of the gate of his city. ²⁵On the third day, when they were sore, two of Jacob’s sons, Simeon and Levi, Dinah’s brothers, each took his sword, came upon the unsuspecting city, and killed all the males. ²⁶They killed Hamor and Shechem, his son, with the edge of the sword, and took Dinah out of Shechem’s house, and went away. ²⁷Jacob’s sons came on the dead, and plundered the city, because they had defiled their sister. ²⁸They took their flocks, their herds, their donkeys, that which was in the city, that which was in the field, ²⁹and all their wealth. They took captive all their little ones and their wives, and took as plunder everything that was in the house. ³⁰Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, “You have troubled me, to make me odious to the inhabitants of the land, among the Canaanites and the Perizzites. I am few in number. They will gather themselves together against me and strike me, and I will be destroyed, I and my house.” ³¹They said, “Should he deal with our sister as with a prostitute?”

35 God said to Jacob, “Arise, go up to Bethel, and live there. Make there an altar to God, who appeared to you when you fled from the face of Esau your brother.” ²Then Jacob said to his household, and to all who were with him, “Put away the foreign gods that are among you, purify yourselves, and change your garments. ³Let’s arise, and go up to Bethel. I will make there an altar to God, who answered me in the day of my distress, and was with me on the way which I went.” ⁴They gave to Jacob all the foreign gods which were in their hands, and the rings which were

in their ears; and Jacob hid them under the oak which was by Shechem. ⁵They traveled, and a terror of God was on the cities that were around them, and they didn’t pursue the sons of Jacob. ⁶So Jacob came to Luz (that is, Bethel), which is in the land of Canaan, he and all the people who were with him. ⁷He built an altar there, and called the place El Beth El; because there God was revealed to him, when he fled from the face of his brother. ⁸Deborah, Rebekah’s nurse, died, and she was buried below Bethel under the oak; and its name was called Allon Bacuth. ⁹God appeared to Jacob again, when he came from Paddan Aram, and blessed him. ¹⁰God said to him, “Your name is Jacob. Your name shall not be Jacob any more, but your name will be Israel.” He named him Israel. ¹¹God said to him, “I am God Almighty. Be fruitful and multiply. A nation and a company of nations will be from you, and kings will come out of your body. ¹²The land which I gave to Abraham and Isaac, I will give it to you, and to your offspring after you I will give the land.” ¹³God went up from him in the place where he spoke with him. ¹⁴Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he spoke with him, a pillar of stone. He poured out a drink offering on it, and poured oil on it. ¹⁵Jacob called the name of the place where God spoke with him “Bethel”. ¹⁶They traveled from Bethel. There was still some distance to come to Ephrath, and Rachel travailed. She had hard labor. ¹⁷When she was in hard labor, the midwife said to her, “Don’t be afraid, for now you will have another son.” ¹⁸As her soul was departing (for she died), she named him Benoni, ^{xli} but his father named him Benjamin. ^{xlii} ¹⁹Rachel died, and was buried on the way to Ephrath (also called Bethlehem). ²⁰Jacob set up a pillar on her grave. The same is the Pillar of Rachel’s grave to this day. ²¹Israel traveled, and spread his tent beyond the tower of Eder. ²²While Israel lived in that land, Reuben went and lay with Bilhah, his father’s concubine, and Israel heard of it. Now the sons of Jacob were twelve. ²³The sons of Leah: Reuben (Jacob’s firstborn), Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, and Zebulun. ²⁴The sons of Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin. ²⁵The sons of Bilhah (Rachel’s servant): Dan and Naphtali. ²⁶The sons of Zilpah (Leah’s servant): Gad and Asher. These are the sons of Jacob, who were born to him in Paddan Aram. ²⁷Jacob came to Isaac his father, to Mamre, to Kiriath Arba (which is Hebron), where Abraham and Isaac lived as foreigners. ²⁸The days of Isaac were one hundred eighty years. ²⁹Isaac gave up the spirit and died, and was gathered to his people, old and full of days. Esau and Jacob, his sons, buried him.

36 Now this is the history of the generations of Esau (that is, Edom). ²Esau took his wives from the daughters of Canaan: Adah the daughter of Elon, the Hittite; and Oholibamah the daughter of Anah, the daughter of Zibeon,

^{x1}Hebrew has, literally, “daughter”

^{xli}“Benoni” means “son of my trouble”.

^{xlii}“Benjamin” means “son of my right hand”.

the Hivite; ³and Basemath, Ishmael's daughter, sister of Nebaioth. ⁴Adah bore to Esau Eliphaz. Basemath bore Reuel. ⁵Oholibamah bore Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. These are the sons of Esau, who were born to him in the land of Canaan. ⁶Esau took his wives, his sons, his daughters, and all the members of his household, with his livestock, all his animals, and all his possessions, which he had gathered in the land of Canaan, and went into a land away from his brother Jacob. ⁷For their substance was too great for them to dwell together, and the land of their travels couldn't bear them because of their livestock. ⁸Esau lived in the hill country of Seir. Esau is Edom. ⁹This is the history of the generations of Esau the father of the Edomites in the hill country of Seir: ¹⁰these are the names of Esau's sons: Eliphaz, the son of Adah, the wife of Esau; and Reuel, the son of Basemath, the wife of Esau. ¹¹The sons of Eliphaz were Teman, Omar, Zepho, and Gatam, and Kenaz. ¹²Timna was concubine to Eliphaz, Esau's son; and she bore to Eliphaz Amalek. These are the descendants of Adah, Esau's wife. ¹³These are the sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. These were the descendants of Basemath, Esau's wife. ¹⁴These were the sons of Oholibamah, the daughter of Anah, the daughter of Zibeon, Esau's wife: she bore to Esau Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. ¹⁵These are the chiefs of the sons of Esau: the sons of Eliphaz the firstborn of Esau: chief Teman, chief Omar, chief Zepho, chief Kenaz, ¹⁶chief Korah, chief Gatam, chief Amalek. These are the chiefs who came of Eliphaz in the land of Edom. These are the sons of Adah. ¹⁷These are the sons of Reuel, Esau's son: chief Nahath, chief Zerah, chief Shammah, chief Mizzah. These are the chiefs who came of Reuel in the land of Edom. These are the sons of Basemath, Esau's wife. ¹⁸These are the sons of Oholibamah, Esau's wife: chief Jeush, chief Jalam, chief Korah. These are the chiefs who came of Oholibamah the daughter of Anah, Esau's wife. ¹⁹These are the sons of Esau (that is, Edom), and these are their chiefs. ²⁰These are the sons of Seir the Horite, the inhabitants of the land: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, ²¹Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. These are the chiefs who came of the Horites, the children of Seir in the land of Edom. ²²The children of Lotan were Hori and Heman. Lotan's sister was Timna. ²³These are the children of Shobal: Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and Onam. ²⁴These are the children of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah. This is Anah who found the hot springs in the wilderness, as he fed the donkeys of Zibeon his father. ²⁵These are the children of Anah: Dishon and Oholibamah, the daughter of Anah. ²⁶These are the children of Dishon: Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran. ²⁷These are the children of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan. ²⁸These are the children of Dishan: Uz and Aran. ²⁹These are the chiefs who came of the Horites: chief Lotan, chief Shobal, chief Zibeon, chief Anah, ³⁰chief Dishon, chief Ezer, and chief Dishan. These are the chiefs who came of the Horites, according to

their chiefs in the land of Seir. ³¹These are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom, before any king reigned over the children of Israel. ³²Bela, the son of Beor, reigned in Edom. The name of his city was Dinhabah. ³³Bela died, and Jobab, the son of Zerah of Bozrah, reigned in his place. ³⁴Jobab died, and Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his place. ³⁵Husham died, and Hadad, the son of Bedad, who struck Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his place. The name of his city was Avith. ³⁶Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his place. ³⁷Samlah died, and Shaul of Rehoboth by the river, reigned in his place. ³⁸Shaul died, and Baal Hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his place. ³⁹Baal Hanan the son of Achbor died, and Hadar reigned in his place. The name of his city was Pau. His wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab. ⁴⁰These are the names of the chiefs who came from Esau, according to their families, after their places, and by their names: chief Timna, chief Alvah, chief Jetheth, ⁴¹chief Oholibamah, chief Elah, chief Pinon, ⁴²chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief Mibzar, ⁴³chief Magdiel, and chief Iram. These are the chiefs of Edom, according to their habitations in the land of their possession. This is Esau, the father of the Edomites.

37 Jacob lived in the land of his father's travels, in the land of Canaan. ²This is the history of the generations of Jacob. Joseph, being seventeen years old, was feeding the flock with his brothers. He was a boy with the sons of Bilhah and Zilpah, his father's wives. Joseph brought an evil report of them to their father. ³Now Israel loved Joseph more than all his children, because he was the son of his old age, and he made him a tunic of many colors. ⁴His brothers saw that their father loved him more than all his brothers, and they hated him, and couldn't speak peaceably to him. ⁵Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, "Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf." ⁸His brothers asked him, "Will you indeed reign over us? Will you indeed have dominion over us?" They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words. ⁹He dreamed yet another dream, and told it to his brothers, and said, "Behold, I have dreamed yet another dream: and behold, the sun and the moon and eleven stars bowed down to me." ¹⁰He told it to his father and to his brothers. His father rebuked him, and said to him, "What is this dream that you have dreamed? Will I and your mother and your brothers indeed come to bow ourselves down to the earth before you?" ¹¹His brothers envied him, but his father kept this saying in mind. ¹²His brothers went to feed their father's flock in Shechem. ¹³Israel said to Joseph, "Aren't your brothers feeding the flock in Shechem? Come, and

I will send you to them.” He said to him, “Here I am.”¹⁴He said to him, “Go now, see whether it is well with your brothers, and well with the flock; and bring me word again.” So he sent him out of the valley of Hebron, and he came to Shechem.¹⁵A certain man found him, and behold, he was wandering in the field. The man asked him, “What are you looking for?”¹⁶He said, “I am looking for my brothers. Tell me, please, where they are feeding the flock.”¹⁷The man said, “They have left here, for I heard them say, ‘Let’s go to Dothan.’” Joseph went after his brothers, and found them in Dothan.¹⁸They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him.¹⁹They said to one another, “Behold, this dreamer comes.²⁰Come now therefore, and let’s kill him, and cast him into one of the pits, and we will say, ‘An evil animal has devoured him.’ We will see what will become of his dreams.”²¹Reuben heard it, and delivered him out of their hand, and said, “Let’s not take his life.”²²Reuben said to them, “Shed no blood. Throw him into this pit that is in the wilderness, but lay no hand on him”—that he might deliver him out of their hand, to restore him to his father.²³When Joseph came to his brothers, they stripped Joseph of his tunic, the tunic of many colors that was on him;²⁴and they took him, and threw him into the pit. The pit was empty. There was no water in it.²⁵They sat down to eat bread, and they lifted up their eyes and looked, and saw a caravan of Ishmaelites was coming from Gilead, with their camels bearing spices and balm and myrrh, going to carry it down to Egypt.²⁶Judah said to his brothers, “What profit is it if we kill our brother and conceal his blood?²⁷Come, and let’s sell him to the Ishmaelites, and not let our hand be on him; for he is our brother, our flesh.” His brothers listened to him.²⁸Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. The merchants brought Joseph into Egypt.²⁹Reuben returned to the pit, and saw that Joseph wasn’t in the pit; and he tore his clothes.³⁰He returned to his brothers, and said, “The child is no more; and I, where will I go?”³¹They took Joseph’s tunic, and killed a male goat, and dipped the tunic in the blood.³²They took the tunic of many colors, and they brought it to their father, and said, “We have found this. Examine it, now, and see if it is your son’s tunic or not.”³³He recognized it, and said, “It is my son’s tunic. An evil animal has devoured him. Joseph is without doubt torn in pieces.”³⁴Jacob tore his clothes, and put sackcloth on his waist, and mourned for his son many days.³⁵All his sons and all his daughters rose up to comfort him, but he refused to be comforted. He said, “For I will go down to Sheol ^{xliii} to my son, mourning.” His father wept for him.³⁶The Midianites sold him into Egypt to Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh’s, the captain of

the guard.

38At that time, Judah went down from his brothers, and visited a certain Adullamite, whose name was Hirah.²There, Judah saw the daughter of a certain Canaanite man named Shua. He took her, and went in to her.³She conceived, and bore a son; and he named him Er.⁴She conceived again, and bore a son; and she named him Onan.⁵She yet again bore a son, and named him Shelah. He was at Chezib when she bore him.⁶Judah took a wife for Er, his firstborn, and her name was Tamar.⁷Er, Judah’s firstborn, was wicked in the LORD’s sight. So the LORD killed him.⁸Judah said to Onan, “Go in to your brother’s wife, and perform the duty of a husband’s brother to her, and raise up offspring for your brother.”⁹Onan knew that the offspring wouldn’t be his; and when he went in to his brother’s wife, he spilled his semen on the ground, lest he should give offspring to his brother.¹⁰The thing which he did was evil in the LORD’s sight, and he killed him also.¹¹Then Judah said to Tamar, his daughter-in-law, “Remain a widow in your father’s house, until Shelah, my son, is grown up;” for he said, “Lest he also die, like his brothers.” Tamar went and lived in her father’s house.¹²After many days, Shua’s daughter, the wife of Judah, died. Judah was comforted, and went up to his sheep shearers to Timnah, he and his friend Hirah, the Adullamite.¹³Tamar was told, “Behold, your father-in-law is going up to Timnah to shear his sheep.”¹⁴She took off the garments of her widowhood, and covered herself with her veil, and wrapped herself, and sat in the gate of Enaim, which is on the way to Timnah; for she saw that Shelah was grown up, and she wasn’t given to him as a wife.¹⁵When Judah saw her, he thought that she was a prostitute, for she had covered her face.¹⁶He turned to her by the way, and said, “Please come, let me come in to you,” for he didn’t know that she was his daughter-in-law. She said, “What will you give me, that you may come in to me?”¹⁷He said, “I will send you a young goat from the flock.” She said, “Will you give me a pledge, until you send it?”¹⁸He said, “What pledge will I give you?” She said, “Your signet and your cord, and your staff that is in your hand.” He gave them to her, and came in to her, and she conceived by him.¹⁹She arose, and went away, and put off her veil from her, and put on the garments of her widowhood.²⁰Judah sent the young goat by the hand of his friend, the Adullamite, to receive the pledge from the woman’s hand, but he didn’t find her.²¹Then he asked the men of her place, saying, “Where is the prostitute, that was at Enaim by the road?” They said, “There has been no prostitute here.”²²He returned to Judah, and said, “I haven’t found her; and also the men of the place said, ‘There has been no prostitute here.’”²³Judah said, “Let her keep it, lest we be shamed. Behold, I sent this young goat, and you haven’t found her.”²⁴About three months later, Judah was told, “Tamar, your

^{xliii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

daughter-in-law, has played the prostitute. Moreover, behold, she is with child by prostitution.” Judah said, “Bring her out, and let her be burned.” ²⁵When she was brought out, she sent to her father-in-law, saying, “I am with child by the man who owns these.” She also said, “Please discern whose these are—the signet, and the cords, and the staff.” ²⁶Judah acknowledged them, and said, “She is more righteous than I, because I didn’t give her to Shelah, my son.” He knew her again no more. ²⁷In the time of her travail, behold, twins were in her womb. ²⁸When she travailed, one put out a hand, and the midwife took and tied a scarlet thread on his hand, saying, “This came out first.” ²⁹As he drew back his hand, behold, his brother came out, and she said, “Why have you made a breach for yourself?” Therefore his name was called Perez. ^{xliv} ³⁰Afterward his brother came out, who had the scarlet thread on his hand, and his name was called Zerah. ^{xliv}

39 Joseph was brought down to Egypt. Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh’s, the captain of the guard, an Egyptian, bought him from the hand of the Ishmaelites that had brought him down there. ²The LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man. He was in the house of his master the Egyptian. ³His master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did prosper in his hand. ⁴Joseph found favor in his sight. He ministered to him, and Potiphar made him overseer over his house, and all that he had he put into his hand. ⁵From the time that he made him overseer in his house, and over all that he had, the LORD blessed the Egyptian’s house for Joseph’s sake. The LORD’s blessing was on all that he had, in the house and in the field. ⁶He left all that he had in Joseph’s hand. He didn’t concern himself with anything, except for the food which he ate. Joseph was well-built and handsome. ⁷After these things, his master’s wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, “Lie with me.” ⁸But he refused, and said to his master’s wife, “Behold, my master doesn’t know what is with me in the house, and he has put all that he has into my hand. ⁹No one is greater in this house than I am, and he has not kept back anything from me but you, because you are his wife. How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?” ¹⁰As she spoke to Joseph day by day, he didn’t listen to her, to lie by her, or to be with her. ¹¹About this time, he went into the house to do his work, and there were none of the men of the house inside. ¹²She caught him by his garment, saying, “Lie with me!” He left his garment in her hand, and ran outside. ¹³When she saw that he had left his garment in her hand, and had run outside, ¹⁴she called to the men of her house, and spoke to them, saying, “Behold, he has brought a Hebrew in to us to mock us. He came in to me to lie with me, and I cried with a loud

voice. ¹⁵When he heard that I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment by me, and ran outside.” ¹⁶She laid up his garment by her, until his master came home. ¹⁷She spoke to him according to these words, saying, “The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought to us, came in to me to mock me, ¹⁸and as I lifted up my voice and cried, he left his garment by me, and ran outside.” ¹⁹When his master heard the words of his wife, which she spoke to him, saying, “This is what your servant did to me,” his wrath was kindled. ²⁰Joseph’s master took him, and put him into the prison, the place where the king’s prisoners were bound, and he was there in custody. ²¹But the LORD was with Joseph, and showed kindness to him, and gave him favor in the sight of the keeper of the prison. ²²The keeper of the prison committed to Joseph’s hand all the prisoners who were in the prison. Whatever they did there, he was responsible for it. ²³The keeper of the prison didn’t look after anything that was under his hand, because the LORD was with him; and that which he did, the LORD made it prosper.

40 After these things, the butler of the king of Egypt and his baker offended their lord, the king of Egypt. ²Pharaoh was angry with his two officers, the chief cup bearer and the chief baker. ³He put them in custody in the house of the captain of the guard, into the prison, the place where Joseph was bound. ⁴The captain of the guard assigned them to Joseph, and he took care of them. They stayed in prison many days. ⁵They both dreamed a dream, each man his dream, in one night, each man according to the interpretation of his dream, the cup bearer and the baker of the king of Egypt, who were bound in the prison. ⁶Joseph came in to them in the morning, and saw them, and saw that they were sad. ⁷He asked Pharaoh’s officers who were with him in custody in his master’s house, saying, “Why do you look so sad today?” ⁸They said to him, “We have dreamed a dream, and there is no one who can interpret it.” Joseph said to them, “Don’t interpretations belong to God? Please tell it to me.” ⁹The chief cup bearer told his dream to Joseph, and said to him, “In my dream, behold, a vine was in front of me, ¹⁰and in the vine were three branches. It was as though it budded, it blossomed, and its clusters produced ripe grapes. ¹¹Pharaoh’s cup was in my hand; and I took the grapes, and pressed them into Pharaoh’s cup, and I gave the cup into Pharaoh’s hand.” ¹²Joseph said to him, “This is its interpretation: the three branches are three days. ¹³Within three more days, Pharaoh will lift up your head, and restore you to your office. You will give Pharaoh’s cup into his hand, the way you did when you were his cup bearer. ¹⁴But remember me when it is well with you. Please show kindness to me, and make mention of me to Pharaoh, and bring me out of this house. ¹⁵For indeed, I was stolen away out of the land of the Hebrews, and here also I have done nothing

^{xliv}Perez means “breaking out”.

^{xliv}Zerah means “scarlet” or “brightness”.

that they should put me into the dungeon.” ¹⁶When the chief baker saw that the interpretation was good, he said to Joseph, “I also was in my dream, and behold, three baskets of white bread were on my head. ¹⁷In the uppermost basket there were all kinds of baked food for Pharaoh, and the birds ate them out of the basket on my head.” ¹⁸Joseph answered, “This is its interpretation. The three baskets are three days. ¹⁹Within three more days, Pharaoh will lift up your head from off you, and will hang you on a tree; and the birds will eat your flesh from off you.” ²⁰On the third day, which was Pharaoh’s birthday, he made a feast for all his servants, and he lifted up the head of the chief cup bearer and the head of the chief baker among his servants. ²¹He restored the chief cup bearer to his position again, and he gave the cup into Pharaoh’s hand; ²²but he hanged the chief baker, as Joseph had interpreted to them. ²³Yet the chief cup bearer didn’t remember Joseph, but forgot him.

⁴¹At the end of two full years, Pharaoh dreamed, and behold, he stood by the river. ²Behold, seven cattle came up out of the river. They were sleek and fat, and they fed in the marsh grass. ³Behold, seven other cattle came up after them out of the river, ugly and thin, and stood by the other cattle on the brink of the river. ⁴The ugly and thin cattle ate up the seven sleek and fat cattle. So Pharaoh awoke. ⁵He slept and dreamed a second time; and behold, seven heads of grain came up on one stalk, healthy and good. ⁶Behold, seven heads of grain, thin and blasted with the east wind, sprung up after them. ⁷The thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven healthy and full ears. Pharaoh awoke, and behold, it was a dream. ⁸In the morning, his spirit was troubled, and he sent and called for all of Egypt’s magicians and wise men. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but there was no one who could interpret them to Pharaoh. ⁹Then the chief cup bearer spoke to Pharaoh, saying, “I remember my faults today. ¹⁰Pharaoh was angry with his servants, and put me in custody in the house of the captain of the guard, with the chief baker. ¹¹We dreamed a dream in one night, he and I. Each man dreamed according to the interpretation of his dream. ¹²There was with us there a young man, a Hebrew, servant to the captain of the guard, and we told him, and he interpreted to us our dreams. He interpreted to each man according to his dream. ¹³As he interpreted to us, so it was. He restored me to my office, and he hanged him.” ¹⁴Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon. He shaved himself, changed his clothing, and came in to Pharaoh. ¹⁵Pharaoh said to Joseph, “I have dreamed a dream, and there is no one who can interpret it. I have heard it said of you, that when you hear a dream you can interpret it.” ¹⁶Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, “It isn’t in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.” ¹⁷Pharaoh spoke to Joseph,

“In my dream, behold, I stood on the brink of the river; ¹⁸and behold, seven fat and sleek cattle came up out of the river. They fed in the marsh grass; ¹⁹and behold, seven other cattle came up after them, poor and very ugly and thin, such as I never saw in all the land of Egypt for ugliness. ²⁰The thin and ugly cattle ate up the first seven fat cattle; ²¹and when they had eaten them up, it couldn’t be known that they had eaten them, but they were still ugly, as at the beginning. So I awoke. ²²I saw in my dream, and behold, seven heads of grain came up on one stalk, full and good; ²³and behold, seven heads of grain, withered, thin, and blasted with the east wind, sprung up after them. ²⁴The thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven good heads of grain. I told it to the magicians, but there was no one who could explain it to me.” ²⁵Joseph said to Pharaoh, “The dream of Pharaoh is one. What God is about to do he has declared to Pharaoh. ²⁶The seven good cattle are seven years; and the seven good heads of grain are seven years. The dream is one. ²⁷The seven thin and ugly cattle that came up after them are seven years, and also the seven empty heads of grain blasted with the east wind; they will be seven years of famine. ²⁸That is the thing which I have spoken to Pharaoh. God has shown Pharaoh what he is about to do. ²⁹Behold, seven years of great plenty throughout all the land of Egypt are coming. ³⁰Seven years of famine will arise after them, and all the plenty will be forgotten in the land of Egypt. The famine will consume the land, ³¹and the plenty will not be known in the land by reason of that famine which follows; for it will be very grievous. ³²The dream was doubled to Pharaoh, because the thing is established by God, and God will shortly bring it to pass. ³³“Now therefore let Pharaoh look for a discreet and wise man, and set him over the land of Egypt. ³⁴Let Pharaoh do this, and let him appoint overseers over the land, and take up the fifth part of the land of Egypt’s produce in the seven plenteous years. ³⁵Let them gather all the food of these good years that come, and store grain under the hand of Pharaoh for food in the cities, and let them keep it. ³⁶The food will be to supply the land against the seven years of famine, which will be in the land of Egypt; so that the land will not perish through the famine.” ³⁷The thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants. ³⁸Pharaoh said to his servants, “Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?” ³⁹Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you. ⁴⁰You shall be over my house. All my people will be ruled according to your word. Only in the throne I will be greater than you.” ⁴¹Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Behold, I have set you over all the land of Egypt.” ⁴²Pharaoh took off his signet ring from his hand, and put it on Joseph’s hand, and arrayed him in robes of fine linen, and put a gold chain about his neck. ⁴³He made him ride in the second chariot which he

had. They cried before him, “Bow the knee!” He set him over all the land of Egypt. ⁴⁴Pharaoh said to Joseph, “I am Pharaoh. Without you, no man shall lift up his hand or his foot in all the land of Egypt.” ⁴⁵Pharaoh called Joseph’s name Zaphenath-Paneah. He gave him Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera priest of On as a wife. Joseph went out over the land of Egypt. ⁴⁶Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt. ⁴⁷In the seven plentiful years the earth produced abundantly. ⁴⁸He gathered up all the food of the seven years which were in the land of Egypt, and laid up the food in the cities. He stored food in each city from the fields around that city. ⁴⁹Joseph laid up grain as the sand of the sea, very much, until he stopped counting, for it was without number. ⁵⁰To Joseph were born two sons before the year of famine came, whom Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera priest of On, bore to him. ⁵¹Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasseh, ^{xlvi}“For”, he said, “God has made me forget all my toil, and all my father’s house.” ⁵²The name of the second, he called Ephraim: ^{xlvi}“For God has made me fruitful in the land of my affliction.” ⁵³The seven years of plenty, that were in the land of Egypt, came to an end. ⁵⁴The seven years of famine began to come, just as Joseph had said. There was famine in all lands, but in all the land of Egypt there was bread. ⁵⁵When all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread, and Pharaoh said to all the Egyptians, “Go to Joseph. What he says to you, do.” ⁵⁶The famine was over all the surface of the earth. Joseph opened all the store houses, and sold to the Egyptians. The famine was severe in the land of Egypt. ⁵⁷All countries came into Egypt, to Joseph, to buy grain, because the famine was severe in all the earth.

42Now Jacob saw that there was grain in Egypt, and Jacob said to his sons, “Why do you look at one another?” ²He said, “Behold, I have heard that there is grain in Egypt. Go down there, and buy for us from there, so that we may live, and not die.” ³Joseph’s ten brothers went down to buy grain from Egypt. ⁴But Jacob didn’t send Benjamin, Joseph’s brother, with his brothers; for he said, “Lest perhaps harm happen to him.” ⁵The sons of Israel came to buy among those who came, for the famine was in the land of Canaan. ⁶Joseph was the governor over the land. It was he who sold to all the people of the land. Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth. ⁷Joseph saw his brothers, and he recognized them, but acted like a stranger to them, and spoke roughly with them. He said to them, “Where did you come from?” They said, “From the land of Canaan, to buy food.” ⁸Joseph recognized his brothers,

but they didn’t recognize him. ⁹Joseph remembered the dreams which he dreamed about them, and said to them, “You are spies! You have come to see the nakedness of the land.” ¹⁰They said to him, “No, my lord, but your servants have come to buy food.” ¹¹We are all one man’s sons; we are honest men. Your servants are not spies.” ¹²He said to them, “No, but you have come to see the nakedness of the land!” ¹³They said, “We, your servants, are twelve brothers, the sons of one man in the land of Canaan; and behold, the youngest is today with our father, and one is no more.” ¹⁴Joseph said to them, “It is like I told you, saying, ‘You are spies!’” ¹⁵By this you shall be tested. By the life of Pharaoh, you shall not go out from here, unless your youngest brother comes here. ¹⁶Send one of you, and let him get your brother, and you shall be bound, that your words may be tested, whether there is truth in you, or else by the life of Pharaoh surely you are spies.” ¹⁷He put them all together into custody for three days. ¹⁸Joseph said to them the third day, “Do this, and live, for I fear God. ¹⁹If you are honest men, then let one of your brothers be bound in your prison; but you go, carry grain for the famine of your houses. ²⁰Bring your youngest brother to me; so will your words be verified, and you won’t die.” They did so. ²¹They said to one another, “We are certainly guilty concerning our brother, in that we saw the distress of his soul, when he begged us, and we wouldn’t listen. Therefore this distress has come upon us.” ²²Reuben answered them, saying, “Didn’t I tell you, saying, ‘Don’t sin against the child,’ and you wouldn’t listen? Therefore also, behold, his blood is required.” ²³They didn’t know that Joseph understood them; for there was an interpreter between them. ²⁴He turned himself away from them, and wept. Then he returned to them, and spoke to them, and took Simeon from among them, and bound him before their eyes. ²⁵Then Joseph gave a command to fill their bags with grain, and to restore each man’s money into his sack, and to give them food for the way. So it was done to them. ²⁶They loaded their donkeys with their grain, and departed from there. ²⁷As one of them opened his sack to give his donkey food in the lodging place, he saw his money. Behold, it was in the mouth of his sack. ²⁸He said to his brothers, “My money is restored! Behold, it is in my sack!” Their hearts failed them, and they turned trembling to one another, saying, “What is this that God has done to us?” ²⁹They came to Jacob their father, to the land of Canaan, and told him all that had happened to them, saying, ³⁰“The man, the lord of the land, spoke roughly with us, and took us for spies of the country. ³¹We said to him, ‘We are honest men. We are no spies. ³²We are twelve brothers, sons of our father; one is no more, and the youngest is today with our father in the land of Canaan.’” ³³The man, the lord of the land, said to us, ‘By this I will know that you are honest men: leave one of your brothers with me, and take grain

^{xlvi}“Manasseh” sounds like the Hebrew for “forget”.

^{xlvi}“Ephraim” sounds like the Hebrew for “twice fruitful”.

for the famine of your houses, and go your way. ³⁴Bring your youngest brother to me. Then I will know that you are not spies, but that you are honest men. So I will deliver your brother to you, and you shall trade in the land.” ³⁵As they emptied their sacks, behold, each man’s bundle of money was in his sack. When they and their father saw their bundles of money, they were afraid. ³⁶Jacob, their father, said to them, “You have bereaved me of my children! Joseph is no more, Simeon is no more, and you want to take Benjamin away. All these things are against me.” ³⁷Reuben spoke to his father, saying, “Kill my two sons, if I don’t bring him to you. Entrust him to my care, and I will bring him to you again.” ³⁸He said, “My son shall not go down with you; for his brother is dead, and he only is left. If harm happens to him along the way in which you go, then you will bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to Sheol.” ^{xlviii}

43The famine was severe in the land. ²When they had eaten up the grain which they had brought out of Egypt, their father said to them, “Go again, buy us a little more food.” ³Judah spoke to him, saying, “The man solemnly warned us, saying, ‘You shall not see my face, unless your brother is with you.’ ⁴If you’ll send our brother with us, we’ll go down and buy you food; ⁵but if you don’t send him, we won’t go down, for the man said to us, ‘You shall not see my face, unless your brother is with you.’” ⁶Israel said, “Why did you treat me so badly, telling the man that you had another brother?” ⁷They said, “The man asked directly concerning ourselves, and concerning our relatives, saying, ‘Is your father still alive? Have you another brother?’ We just answered his questions. Is there any way we could know that he would say, ‘Bring your brother down?’” ⁸Judah said to Israel, his father, “Send the boy with me, and we’ll get up and go, so that we may live, and not die, both we, and you, and also our little ones. ⁹I’ll be collateral for him. From my hand will you require him. If I don’t bring him to you, and set him before you, then let me bear the blame forever; ¹⁰for if we hadn’t delayed, surely we would have returned a second time by now.” ¹¹Their father, Israel, said to them, “If it must be so, then do this: Take from the choice fruits of the land in your bags, and carry down a present for the man, a little balm, a little honey, spices and myrrh, nuts, and almonds; ¹²and take double money in your hand, and take back the money that was returned in the mouth of your sacks. Perhaps it was an oversight. ¹³Take your brother also, get up, and return to the man. ¹⁴May God Almighty give you mercy before the man, that he may release to you your other brother and Benjamin. If I am bereaved of my children, I am bereaved.” ¹⁵The men took that present, and they took double money in their hand, and Benjamin; and got up, went down to Egypt, and stood before Joseph.

^{xlviii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

¹⁶When Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the steward of his house, “Bring the men into the house, and butcher an animal, and prepare; for the men will dine with me at noon.” ¹⁷The man did as Joseph commanded, and the man brought the men to Joseph’s house. ¹⁸The men were afraid, because they were brought to Joseph’s house; and they said, “Because of the money that was returned in our sacks the first time, we’re brought in; that he may seek occasion against us, attack us, and seize us as slaves, along with our donkeys.” ¹⁹They came near to the steward of Joseph’s house, and they spoke to him at the door of the house, ²⁰and said, “Oh, my lord, we indeed came down the first time to buy food. ²¹When we came to the lodging place, we opened our sacks, and behold, each man’s money was in the mouth of his sack, our money in full weight. We have brought it back in our hand. ²²We have brought down other money in our hand to buy food. We don’t know who put our money in our sacks.” ²³He said, “Peace be to you. Don’t be afraid. Your God, and the God of your father, has given you treasure in your sacks. I received your money.” He brought Simeon out to them. ²⁴The man brought the men into Joseph’s house, and gave them water, and they washed their feet. He gave their donkeys fodder. ²⁵They prepared the present for Joseph’s coming at noon, for they heard that they should eat bread there. ²⁶When Joseph came home, they brought him the present which was in their hand into the house, and bowed themselves down to the earth before him. ²⁷He asked them of their welfare, and said, “Is your father well, the old man of whom you spoke? Is he yet alive?” ²⁸They said, “Your servant, our father, is well. He is still alive.” They bowed down humbly. ²⁹He lifted up his eyes, and saw Benjamin, his brother, his mother’s son, and said, “Is this your youngest brother, of whom you spoke to me?” He said, “God be gracious to you, my son.” ³⁰Joseph hurried, for his heart yearned over his brother; and he sought a place to weep. He entered into his room, and wept there. ³¹He washed his face, and came out. He controlled himself, and said, “Serve the meal.” ³²They served him by himself, and them by themselves, and the Egyptians who ate with him by themselves, because the Egyptians don’t eat with the Hebrews, for that is an abomination to the Egyptians. ³³They sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright, and the youngest according to his youth, and the men marveled with one another. ³⁴He sent portions to them from before him, but Benjamin’s portion was five times as much as any of theirs. They drank, and were merry with him.

44He commanded the steward of his house, saying, “Fill the men’s sacks with food, as much as they can carry, and put each man’s money in his sack’s mouth. ²Put my cup, the silver cup, in the sack’s mouth of the youngest, with his grain money.” He did according to the word that Joseph had spoken. ³As soon as the morning was light, the men

were sent away, they and their donkeys. ⁴When they had gone out of the city, and were not yet far off, Joseph said to his steward, "Up, follow after the men. When you overtake them, ask them, 'Why have you rewarded evil for good?' ⁵Isn't this that from which my lord drinks, and by which he indeed divines? You have done evil in so doing.'" ⁶He overtook them, and he spoke these words to them. ⁷They said to him, "Why does my lord speak such words as these? Far be it from your servants that they should do such a thing! ⁸Behold, the money, which we found in our sacks' mouths, we brought again to you out of the land of Canaan. How then should we steal silver or gold out of your lord's house? ⁹With whomever of your servants it is found, let him die, and we also will be my lord's slaves." ¹⁰He said, "Now also let it be according to your words. He with whom it is found will be my slave; and you will be blameless." ¹¹Then they hurried, and each man took his sack down to the ground, and each man opened his sack. ¹²He searched, beginning with the oldest, and ending at the youngest. The cup was found in Benjamin's sack. ¹³Then they tore their clothes, and each man loaded his donkey, and returned to the city. ¹⁴Judah and his brothers came to Joseph's house, and he was still there. They fell on the ground before him. ¹⁵Joseph said to them, "What deed is this that you have done? Don't you know that such a man as I can indeed do divination?" ¹⁶Judah said, "What will we tell my lord? What will we speak? How will we clear ourselves? God has found out the iniquity of your servants. Behold, we are my lord's slaves, both we and he also in whose hand the cup is found." ¹⁷He said, "Far be it from me that I should do so. The man in whose hand the cup is found, he will be my slave; but as for you, go up in peace to your father." ¹⁸Then Judah came near to him, and said, "Oh, my lord, please let your servant speak a word in my lord's ears, and don't let your anger burn against your servant; for you are even as Pharaoh. ¹⁹My lord asked his servants, saying, 'Have you a father, or a brother?' ²⁰We said to my lord, 'We have a father, an old man, and a child of his old age, a little one; and his brother is dead, and he alone is left of his mother; and his father loves him.' ²¹You said to your servants, 'Bring him down to me, that I may set my eyes on him.' ²²We said to my lord, 'The boy can't leave his father, for if he should leave his father, his father would die.' ²³You said to your servants, 'Unless your youngest brother comes down with you, you will see my face no more.' ²⁴When we came up to your servant my father, we told him the words of my lord. ²⁵Our father said, 'Go again and buy us a little food.' ²⁶We said, 'We can't go down. If our youngest brother is with us, then we will go down: for we may not see the man's face, unless our youngest brother is with us.' ²⁷Your servant, my father, said to us, 'You know that my wife bore me two sons. ²⁸One went out from me, and I said, 'Surely he is torn in pieces;' and I haven't seen him since. ²⁹If you

take this one also from me, and harm happens to him, you will bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to Sheol.' ^{xlix} ³⁰Now therefore when I come to your servant my father, and the boy is not with us; since his life is bound up in the boy's life; ³¹it will happen, when he sees that the boy is no more, that he will die. Your servants will bring down the gray hairs of your servant, our father, with sorrow to Sheol. ¹ ³²For your servant became collateral for the boy to my father, saying, 'If I don't bring him to you, then I will bear the blame to my father forever.' ³³Now therefore, please let your servant stay instead of the boy, my lord's slave; and let the boy go up with his brothers. ³⁴For how will I go up to my father, if the boy isn't with me?—lest I see the evil that will come on my father."

45Then Joseph couldn't control himself before all those who stood before him, and he called out, "Cause everyone to go out from me!" No one else stood with him, while Joseph made himself known to his brothers. ²He wept aloud. The Egyptians heard, and the house of Pharaoh heard. ³Joseph said to his brothers, "I am Joseph! Does my father still live?" His brothers couldn't answer him; for they were terrified at his presence. ⁴Joseph said to his brothers, "Come near to me, please." They came near. He said, "I am Joseph, your brother, whom you sold into Egypt. ⁵Now don't be grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that you sold me here, for God sent me before you to preserve life. ⁶For these two years the famine has been in the land, and there are yet five years, in which there will be no plowing and no harvest. ⁷God sent me before you to preserve for you a remnant in the earth, and to save you alive by a great deliverance. ⁸So now it wasn't you who sent me here, but God, and he has made me a father to Pharaoh, lord of all his house, and ruler over all the land of Egypt. ⁹Hurry, and go up to my father, and tell him, 'This is what your son Joseph says, "God has made me lord of all Egypt. Come down to me. Don't wait. ¹⁰You shall dwell in the land of Goshen, and you will be near to me, you, your children, your children's children, your flocks, your herds, and all that you have. ¹¹There I will provide for you; for there are yet five years of famine; lest you come to poverty, you, and your household, and all that you have.'" ¹²Behold, your eyes see, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin, that it is my mouth that speaks to you. ¹³You shall tell my father of all my glory in Egypt, and of all that you have seen. You shall hurry and bring my father down here." ¹⁴He fell on his brother Benjamin's neck and wept, and Benjamin wept on his neck. ¹⁵He kissed all his brothers, and wept on them. After that his brothers talked with him. ¹⁶The report of it was heard in Pharaoh's house, saying, "Joseph's brothers have come." It pleased Pharaoh well, and his servants. ¹⁷Pharaoh said to

^{xlix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

¹Sheol is the place of the dead.

Joseph, "Tell your brothers, 'Do this: Load your animals, and go, travel to the land of Canaan. ¹⁸Take your father and your households, and come to me, and I will give you the good of the land of Egypt, and you will eat the fat of the land.' ¹⁹Now you are commanded to do this: Take wagons out of the land of Egypt for your little ones, and for your wives, and bring your father, and come. ²⁰Also, don't concern yourselves about your belongings, for the good of all the land of Egypt is yours." ²¹The sons of Israel did so. Joseph gave them wagons, according to the commandment of Pharaoh, and gave them provision for the way. ²²He gave each one of them changes of clothing, but to Benjamin he gave three hundred pieces of silver and five changes of clothing. ²³He sent the following to his father: ten donkeys loaded with the good things of Egypt, and ten female donkeys loaded with grain and bread and provision for his father by the way. ²⁴So he sent his brothers away, and they departed. He said to them, "See that you don't quarrel on the way." ²⁵They went up out of Egypt, and came into the land of Canaan, to Jacob their father. ²⁶They told him, saying, "Joseph is still alive, and he is ruler over all the land of Egypt." His heart fainted, for he didn't believe them. ²⁷They told him all the words of Joseph, which he had said to them. When he saw the wagons which Joseph had sent to carry him, the spirit of Jacob, their father, revived. ²⁸Israel said, "It is enough. Joseph my son is still alive. I will go and see him before I die."

⁴⁶Israel traveled with all that he had, and came to Beersheba, and offered sacrifices to the God of his father, Isaac. ²God spoke to Israel in the visions of the night, and said, "Jacob, Jacob!" He said, "Here I am." ³He said, "I am God, the God of your father. Don't be afraid to go down into Egypt, for there I will make of you a great nation. ⁴I will go down with you into Egypt. I will also surely bring you up again. Joseph's hand will close your eyes." ⁵Jacob rose up from Beersheba, and the sons of Israel carried Jacob, their father, their little ones, and their wives, in the wagons which Pharaoh had sent to carry him. ⁶They took their livestock, and their goods, which they had gotten in the land of Canaan, and came into Egypt—Jacob, and all his offspring with him, ⁷his sons, and his sons' sons with him, his daughters, and his sons' daughters, and he brought all his offspring with him into Egypt. ⁸These are the names of the children of Israel, who came into Egypt, Jacob and his sons: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn. ⁹The sons of Reuben: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi. ¹⁰The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman. ¹¹The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. ¹²The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, Shelah, Perez, and Zerah; but Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. The sons of Perez were Hezron and Hamul. ¹³The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puvah,

Job, and Shimron. ¹⁴The sons of Zebulun: Sered, Elon, and Jahleel. ¹⁵These are the sons of Leah, whom she bore to Jacob in Paddan Aram, with his daughter Dinah. All the souls of his sons and his daughters were thirty-three. ¹⁶The sons of Gad: Ziphion, Haggi, Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Ardodi, and Areli. ¹⁷The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, Beriah, and Serah their sister. The sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel. ¹⁸These are the sons of Zilpah, whom Laban gave to Leah, his daughter, and these she bore to Jacob, even sixteen souls. ¹⁹The sons of Rachel, Jacob's wife: Joseph and Benjamin. ²⁰To Joseph in the land of Egypt were born Manasseh and Ephraim, whom Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera, priest of On, bore to him. ²¹The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher, Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh, Muppim, Huppim, and Ard. ²²These are the sons of Rachel, who were born to Jacob: all the souls were fourteen. ²³The son of Dan: Hushim. ²⁴The sons of Naphtali: Jahzeel, Guni, Jezer, and Shillem. ²⁵These are the sons of Bilhah, whom Laban gave to Rachel, his daughter, and these she bore to Jacob: all the souls were seven. ²⁶All the souls who came with Jacob into Egypt, who were his direct offspring, in addition to Jacob's sons' wives, all the souls were sixty-six. ²⁷The sons of Joseph, who were born to him in Egypt, were two souls. All the souls of the house of Jacob, who came into Egypt, were seventy. ²⁸Jacob sent Judah before him to Joseph, to show the way before him to Goshen, and they came into the land of Goshen. ²⁹Joseph prepared his chariot, and went up to meet Israel, his father, in Goshen. He presented himself to him, and fell on his neck, and wept on his neck a good while. ³⁰Israel said to Joseph, "Now let me die, since I have seen your face, that you are still alive." ³¹Joseph said to his brothers, and to his father's house, "I will go up, and speak with Pharaoh, and will tell him, 'My brothers, and my father's house, who were in the land of Canaan, have come to me. ³²These men are shepherds, for they have been keepers of livestock, and they have brought their flocks, and their herds, and all that they have.' ³³It will happen, when Pharaoh summons you, and will say, 'What is your occupation?' ³⁴that you shall say, 'Your servants have been keepers of livestock from our youth even until now, both we, and our fathers:' that you may dwell in the land of Goshen; for every shepherd is an abomination to the Egyptians."

⁴⁷Then Joseph went in and told Pharaoh, and said, "My father and my brothers, with their flocks, their herds, and all that they own, have come out of the land of Canaan; and behold, they are in the land of Goshen." ²From among his brothers he took five men, and presented them to Pharaoh. ³Pharaoh said to his brothers, "What is your occupation?" They said to Pharaoh, "Your servants are shepherds, both we, and our fathers." ⁴They also said to Pharaoh, "We have come to live as foreigners in the land, for there is no pasture for your servants' flocks. For the famine is se-

vere in the land of Canaan. Now therefore, please let your servants dwell in the land of Goshen.” ⁵Pharaoh spoke to Joseph, saying, “Your father and your brothers have come to you. ⁶The land of Egypt is before you. Make your father and your brothers dwell in the best of the land. Let them dwell in the land of Goshen. If you know any able men among them, then put them in charge of my livestock.” ⁷Joseph brought in Jacob, his father, and set him before Pharaoh; and Jacob blessed Pharaoh. ⁸Pharaoh said to Jacob, “How old are you?” ⁹Jacob said to Pharaoh, “The years of my pilgrimage are one hundred thirty years. The days of the years of my life have been few and evil. They have not attained to the days of the years of the life of my fathers in the days of their pilgrimage.” ¹⁰Jacob blessed Pharaoh, and went out from the presence of Pharaoh. ¹¹Joseph placed his father and his brothers, and gave them a possession in the land of Egypt, in the best of the land, in the land of Rameses, as Pharaoh had commanded. ¹²Joseph provided his father, his brothers, and all of his father’s household with bread, according to the sizes of their families. ¹³There was no bread in all the land; for the famine was very severe, so that the land of Egypt and the land of Canaan fainted by reason of the famine. ¹⁴Joseph gathered up all the money that was found in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, for the grain which they bought: and Joseph brought the money into Pharaoh’s house. ¹⁵When the money was all spent in the land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan, all the Egyptians came to Joseph, and said, “Give us bread, for why should we die in your presence? For our money fails.” ¹⁶Joseph said, “Give me your livestock; and I will give you food for your livestock, if your money is gone.” ¹⁷They brought their livestock to Joseph, and Joseph gave them bread in exchange for the horses, and for the flocks, and for the herds, and for the donkeys: and he fed them with bread in exchange for all their livestock for that year. ¹⁸When that year was ended, they came to him the second year, and said to him, “We will not hide from my lord how our money is all spent, and the herds of livestock are my lord’s. There is nothing left in the sight of my lord, but our bodies, and our lands. ¹⁹Why should we die before your eyes, both we and our land? Buy us and our land for bread, and we and our land will be servants to Pharaoh. Give us seed, that we may live, and not die, and that the land won’t be desolate.” ²⁰So Joseph bought all the land of Egypt for Pharaoh, for every man of the Egyptians sold his field, because the famine was severe on them, and the land became Pharaoh’s. ²¹As for the people, he moved them to the cities from one end of the border of Egypt even to the other end of it. ²²Only he didn’t buy the land of the priests, for the priests had a portion from Pharaoh, and ate their portion which Pharaoh gave them. That is why they didn’t sell their land. ²³Then Joseph said to the people, “Behold, I have bought you and your land today

for Pharaoh. Behold, here is seed for you, and you shall sow the land. ²⁴It will happen at the harvests, that you shall give a fifth to Pharaoh, and four parts will be your own, for seed of the field, for your food, for them of your households, and for food for your little ones.” ²⁵They said, “You have saved our lives! Let us find favor in the sight of my lord, and we will be Pharaoh’s servants.” ²⁶Joseph made it a statute concerning the land of Egypt to this day, that Pharaoh should have the fifth. Only the land of the priests alone didn’t become Pharaoh’s. ²⁷Israel lived in the land of Egypt, in the land of Goshen; and they got themselves possessions therein, and were fruitful, and multiplied exceedingly. ²⁸Jacob lived in the land of Egypt seventeen years. So the days of Jacob, the years of his life, were one hundred forty-seven years. ²⁹The time came near that Israel must die, and he called his son Joseph, and said to him, “If now I have found favor in your sight, please put your hand under my thigh, and deal kindly and truly with me. Please don’t bury me in Egypt, ³⁰but when I sleep with my fathers, you shall carry me out of Egypt, and bury me in their burying place.” Joseph said, “I will do as you have said.” ³¹Israel said, “Swear to me,” and he swore to him. Then Israel bowed himself on the bed’s head.

48After these things, someone said to Joseph, “Behold, your father is sick.” He took with him his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim. ²Someone told Jacob, and said, “Behold, your son Joseph comes to you,” and Israel strengthened himself, and sat on the bed. ³Jacob said to Joseph, “God Almighty appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan, and blessed me, ⁴and said to me, ‘Behold, I will make you fruitful, and multiply you, and I will make of you a company of peoples, and will give this land to your offspring after you for an everlasting possession.’ ⁵Now your two sons, who were born to you in the land of Egypt before I came to you into Egypt, are mine; Ephraim and Manasseh, even as Reuben and Simeon, will be mine. ⁶Your offspring, whom you become the father of after them, will be yours. They will be called after the name of their brothers in their inheritance. ⁷As for me, when I came from Paddan, Rachel died beside me in the land of Canaan on the way, when there was still some distance to come to Ephrath, and I buried her there on the way to Ephrath (also called Bethlehem).” ⁸Israel saw Joseph’s sons, and said, “Who are these?” ⁹Joseph said to his father, “They are my sons, whom God has given me here.” He said, “Please bring them to me, and I will bless them.” ¹⁰Now the eyes of Israel were dim for age, so that he couldn’t see well. Joseph brought them near to him; and he kissed them, and embraced them. ¹¹Israel said to Joseph, “I didn’t think I would see your face, and behold, God has let me see your offspring also.” ¹²Joseph brought them out from between his knees, and he bowed himself with his

face to the earth. ¹³Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near to him. ¹⁴Israel stretched out his right hand, and laid it on Ephraim's head, who was the younger, and his left hand on Manasseh's head, guiding his hands knowingly, for Manasseh was the firstborn. ¹⁵He blessed Joseph, and said, "The God before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, the God who has fed me all my life long to this day, ¹⁶the angel who has redeemed me from all evil, bless the lads, and let my name be named on them, and the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac. Let them grow into a multitude upon the earth." ¹⁷When Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand on the head of Ephraim, it displeased him. He held up his father's hand, to remove it from Ephraim's head to Manasseh's head. ¹⁸Joseph said to his father, "Not so, my father, for this is the firstborn. Put your right hand on his head." ¹⁹His father refused, and said, "I know, my son, I know. He also will become a people, and he also will be great. However, his younger brother will be greater than he, and his offspring will become a multitude of nations." ²⁰He blessed them that day, saying, "Israel will bless in you, saying, 'God make you as Ephraim and as Manasseh'" He set Ephraim before Manasseh. ²¹Israel said to Joseph, "Behold, I am dying, but God will be with you, and bring you again to the land of your fathers. ²²Moreover I have given to you one portion above your brothers, which I took out of the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow."

49 Jacob called to his sons, and said: "Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you that which will happen to you in the days to come. ²Assemble yourselves, and hear, you sons of Jacob. Listen to Israel, your father. ³"Reuben, you are my firstborn, my might, and the beginning of my strength, excelling in dignity, and excelling in power. ⁴Boiling over like water, you shall not excel, because you went up to your father's bed, then defiled it. He went up to my couch. ⁵"Simeon and Levi are brothers. Their swords are weapons of violence. ⁶My soul, don't come into their council. My glory, don't be united to their assembly; for in their anger they killed men. In their self-will they hamstrung cattle. ⁷Cursed be their anger, for it was fierce; and their wrath, for it was cruel. I will divide them in Jacob, and scatter them in Israel. ⁸"Judah, your brothers will praise you. Your hand will be on the neck of your enemies. Your father's sons will bow down before you. ⁹Judah is a lion's cub. From the prey, my son, you have gone up. He stooped down, he crouched as a lion, as a lioness. Who will rouse him up? ¹⁰The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he comes to whom it belongs. The obedience of the peoples will be to him. ¹¹Binding his foal to the vine, his donkey's colt to the choice vine, he has washed

his garments in wine, his robes in the blood of grapes. ¹²His eyes will be red with wine, his teeth white with milk. ¹³"Zebulun will dwell at the haven of the sea. He will be for a haven of ships. His border will be on Sidon. ¹⁴"Issachar is a strong donkey, lying down between the saddlebags. ¹⁵He saw a resting place, that it was good, the land, that it was pleasant. He bows his shoulder to the burden, and becomes a servant doing forced labor. ¹⁶"Dan will judge his people, as one of the tribes of Israel. ¹⁷Dan will be a serpent on the trail, an adder in the path, that bites the horse's heels, so that his rider falls backward. ¹⁸I have waited for your salvation, LORD. ¹⁹"A troop will press on Gad, but he will press on their heel. ²⁰"Asher's food will be rich. He will produce royal dainties. ²¹"Naphtali is a doe set free, who bears beautiful fawns. ²²"Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine by a spring. His branches run over the wall. ²³The archers have severely grieved him, shot at him, and persecuted him: ²⁴But his bow remained strong. The arms of his hands were made strong, by the hands of the Mighty One of Jacob, (from there is the shepherd, the stone of Israel), ²⁵even by the God of your father, who will help you, by the Almighty, who will bless you, with blessings of heaven above, blessings of the deep that lies below, blessings of the breasts, and of the womb. ²⁶The blessings of your father have prevailed above the blessings of my ancestors, above the boundaries of the ancient hills. They will be on the head of Joseph, on the crown of the head of him who is separated from his brothers. ²⁷"Benjamin is a ravenous wolf. In the morning he will devour the prey. At evening he will divide the plunder." ²⁸All these are the twelve tribes of Israel, and this is what their father spoke to them, and blessed them. He blessed everyone according to his own blessing. ²⁹He instructed them, and said to them, "I am to be gathered to my people. Bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite, ³⁰in the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, which is before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field from Ephron the Hittite as a burial place. ³¹There they buried Abraham and Sarah, his wife. There they buried Isaac and Rebekah, his wife, and there I buried Leah: ³²the field and the cave that is therein, which was purchased from the children of Heth." ³³When Jacob finished charging his sons, he gathered up his feet into the bed, breathed his last breath, and was gathered to his people.

50 Joseph fell on his father's face, wept on him, and kissed him. ²Joseph commanded his servants, the physicians, to embalm his father; and the physicians embalmed Israel. ³Forty days were used for him, for that is how many days it takes to embalm. The Egyptians wept for Israel for seventy days. ⁴When the days of weeping for him were past, Joseph spoke to Pharaoh's staff, saying, "If now I have found favor in your eyes, please speak in the ears of

Pharaoh, saying, ⁵“My father made me swear, saying, “Behold, I am dying. Bury me in my grave which I have dug for myself in the land of Canaan.” Now therefore, please let me go up and bury my father, and I will come again.” ⁶Pharaoh said, “Go up, and bury your father, just like he made you swear.” ⁷Joseph went up to bury his father; and with him went up all the servants of Pharaoh, the elders of his house, all the elders of the land of Egypt, ⁸all the house of Joseph, his brothers, and his father’s house. Only their little ones, their flocks, and their herds, they left in the land of Goshen. ⁹Both chariots and horsemen went up with him. It was a very great company. ¹⁰They came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is beyond the Jordan, and there they lamented with a very great and severe lamentation. He mourned for his father seven days. ¹¹When the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, saw the mourning in the floor of Atad, they said, “This is a grievous mourning by the Egyptians.” Therefore its name was called Abel Mizraim, which is beyond the Jordan. ¹²His sons did to him just as he commanded them, ¹³for his sons carried him into the land of Canaan, and buried him in the cave of the field of Machpelah, which Abraham bought with the field, as a possession for a burial site, from Ephron the Hittite, near Mamre. ¹⁴Joseph returned into Egypt—he, and his brothers, and all that went up with him to bury his father, after he had buried his father. ¹⁵When Joseph’s brothers saw that their father was dead, they said, “It may be that Joseph will hate us, and will fully pay us back for all the evil which we did to him.” ¹⁶They sent a message to Joseph, saying, “Your father commanded before he died, saying, ¹⁷“You shall tell Joseph, “Now please forgive the disobedience of your brothers, and their sin, because they did evil to you.” Now, please forgive the disobedience of the servants of the God of your father.” Joseph wept when they spoke to him. ¹⁸His brothers also went and fell down before his face; and they said, “Behold, we are your servants.” ¹⁹Joseph said to them, “Don’t be afraid, for am I in the place of God? ²⁰As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good, to save many people alive, as is happening today. ²¹Now therefore don’t be afraid. I will provide for you and your little ones.” He comforted them, and spoke kindly to them. ²²Joseph lived in Egypt, he, and his father’s house. Joseph lived one hundred ten years. ²³Joseph saw Ephraim’s children to the third generation. The children also of Machir, the son of Manasseh, were born on Joseph’s knees. ²⁴Joseph said to his brothers, “I am dying, but God will surely visit you, and bring you up out of this land to the land which he swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.” ²⁵Joseph took an oath from the children of Israel, saying, “God will surely visit you, and you shall carry up my bones from here.” ²⁶So Joseph died, being one hundred ten years old, and they embalmed him, and he was put in a coffin in Egypt.

Exodus

¹Now these are the names of the sons of Israel, who came into Egypt (every man and his household came with Jacob): ²Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah, ³Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin, ⁴Dan and Naphtali, Gad and Asher. ⁵All the souls who came out of Jacob's body were seventy souls, and Joseph was in Egypt already. ⁶Joseph died, as did all his brothers, and all that generation. ⁷The children of Israel were fruitful, and increased abundantly, and multiplied, and grew exceedingly mighty; and the land was filled with them. ⁸Now there arose a new king over Egypt, who didn't know Joseph. ⁹He said to his people, "Behold, ⁱ the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we. ¹⁰Come, let's deal wisely with them, lest they multiply, and it happen that when any war breaks out, they also join themselves to our enemies and fight against us, and escape out of the land." ¹¹Therefore they set taskmasters over them to afflict them with their burdens. They built storage cities for Pharaoh: Pithom and Raamses. ¹²But the more they afflicted them, the more they multiplied and the more they spread out. They started to dread the children of Israel. ¹³The Egyptians ruthlessly made the children of Israel serve, ¹⁴and they made their lives bitter with hard service in mortar and in brick, and in all kinds of service in the field, all their service, in which they ruthlessly made them serve. ¹⁵The king of Egypt spoke to the Hebrew midwives, of whom the name of the one was Shiprah, and the name of the other Puah, ¹⁶and he said, "When you perform the duty of a midwife to the Hebrew women, and see them on the birth stool, if it is a son, then you shall kill him; but if it is a daughter, then she shall live." ¹⁷But the midwives feared God, ⁱⁱ and didn't do what the king of Egypt commanded them, but saved the baby boys alive. ¹⁸The king of Egypt called for the midwives, and said to them, "Why have you done this thing and saved the boys alive?" ¹⁹The midwives said to Pharaoh, "Because the Hebrew women aren't like the Egyptian women; for they are vigorous and give birth before the midwife comes to them." ²⁰God dealt well with the midwives, and the people multiplied, and grew

very mighty. ²¹Because the midwives feared God, he gave them families. ²²Pharaoh commanded all his people, saying, "You shall cast every son who is born into the river, and every daughter you shall save alive."

²A man of the house of Levi went and took a daughter of Levi as his wife. ²The woman conceived and bore a son. When she saw that he was a fine child, she hid him three months. ³When she could no longer hide him, she took a papyrus basket for him, and coated it with tar and with pitch. She put the child in it, and laid it in the reeds by the river's bank. ⁴His sister stood far off, to see what would be done to him. ⁵Pharaoh's daughter came down to bathe at the river. Her maidens walked along by the riverside. She saw the basket among the reeds, and sent her servant to get it. ⁶She opened it, and saw the child, and behold, the baby cried. She had compassion on him, and said, "This is one of the Hebrews' children." ⁷Then his sister said to Pharaoh's daughter, "Should I go and call a nurse for you from the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for you?" ⁸Pharaoh's daughter said to her, "Go." The young woman went and called the child's mother. ⁹Pharaoh's daughter said to her, "Take this child away, and nurse him for me, and I will give you your wages." The woman took the child, and nursed it. ¹⁰The child grew, and she brought him to Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. She named him Moses, ⁱⁱⁱ and said, "Because I drew him out of the water." ¹¹In those days, when Moses had grown up, he went out to his brothers and saw their burdens. He saw an Egyptian striking a Hebrew, one of his brothers. ¹²He looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no one, he killed the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand. ¹³He went out the second day, and behold, two men of the Hebrews were fighting with each other. He said to him who did the wrong, "Why do you strike your fellow?" ¹⁴He said, "Who made you a prince and a judge over us? Do you plan to kill me, as you killed the Egyptian?" Moses was afraid, and said, "Surely this thing is known." ¹⁵Now when Pharaoh heard this thing, he sought to kill Moses. But Moses fled from the face of Pharaoh, and lived in the land of Midian, and he sat down by a well. ¹⁶Now the

ⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱ"Moses" sounds like the Hebrew for "draw out".

priest of Midian had seven daughters. They came and drew water, and filled the troughs to water their father's flock. ¹⁷The shepherds came and drove them away; but Moses stood up and helped them, and watered their flock. ¹⁸When they came to Reuel, their father, he said, "How is it that you have returned so early today?" ¹⁹They said, "An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds, and moreover he drew water for us, and watered the flock." ²⁰He said to his daughters, "Where is he? Why is it that you have left the man? Call him, that he may eat bread." ²¹Moses was content to dwell with the man. He gave Moses Zipporah, his daughter. ²²She bore a son, and he named him Gershom, ^{iv} for he said, "I have lived as a foreigner in a foreign land." ²³In the course of those many days, the king of Egypt died, and the children of Israel sighed because of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up to God because of the bondage. ²⁴God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob. ²⁵God saw the children of Israel, and God understood.

3Now Moses was keeping the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the back of the wilderness, and came to God's mountain, to Horeb. ²The LORD's ^v angel appeared to him in a flame of fire out of the middle of a bush. He looked, and behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed. ³Moses said, "I will go now, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burned." ⁴When the LORD saw that he came over to see, God called to him out of the middle of the bush, and said, "Moses! Moses!" He said, "Here I am." ⁵He said, "Don't come close. Take off your sandals, for the place you are standing on is holy ground." ⁶Moreover he said, "I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob." Moses hid his face because he was afraid to look at God. ⁷The LORD said, "I have surely seen the affliction of my people who are in Egypt, and have heard their cry because of their taskmasters, for I know their sorrows. ⁸I have come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land to a good and large land, to a land flowing with milk and honey; to the place of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite. ⁹Now, behold, the cry of the children of Israel has come to me. Moreover I have seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them. ¹⁰Come now therefore, and I will send you to Pharaoh, that you may bring my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt." ¹¹Moses said to God, "Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh, and that I should bring the children of Israel out of Egypt?" ¹²He said, "Certainly I will be with you.

This will be the token to you, that I have sent you: when you have brought the people out of Egypt, you shall serve God on this mountain." ¹³Moses said to God, "Behold, when I come to the children of Israel, and tell them, 'The God of your fathers has sent me to you,' and they ask me, 'What is his name?' what should I tell them?" ¹⁴God said to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM," and he said, "You shall tell the children of Israel this: 'I AM has sent me to you.'" ¹⁵God said moreover to Moses, "You shall tell the children of Israel this, 'The LORD, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.' This is my name forever, and this is my memorial to all generations. ¹⁶Go and gather the elders of Israel together, and tell them, 'The LORD, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, has appeared to me, saying, 'I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt. ¹⁷I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt to the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, to a land flowing with milk and honey.'" ¹⁸They will listen to your voice. You shall come, you and the elders of Israel, to the king of Egypt, and you shall tell him, 'The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Now please let us go three days' journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to the LORD, our God.' ¹⁹I know that the king of Egypt won't give you permission to go, no, not by a mighty hand. ²⁰I will reach out my hand and strike Egypt with all my wonders which I will do among them, and after that he will let you go. ²¹I will give this people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, and it will happen that when you go, you shall not go empty-handed. ²²But every woman shall ask of her neighbor, and of her who visits her house, jewels of silver, jewels of gold, and clothing. You shall put them on your sons, and on your daughters. You shall plunder the Egyptians."

4Moses answered, "But, behold, they will not believe me, nor listen to my voice; for they will say, 'The LORD has not appeared to you.'" ²The LORD said to him, "What is that in your hand?" He said, "A rod." ³He said, "Throw it on the ground." He threw it on the ground, and it became a snake; and Moses ran away from it. ⁴The LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand, and take it by the tail." He stretched out his hand, and took hold of it, and it became a rod in his hand. ⁵"This is so that they may believe that the LORD, the God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has appeared to you." ⁶The LORD said furthermore to him, "Now put your hand inside your cloak." He put his hand inside his cloak, and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous, as white as snow. ⁷He said, "Put your hand inside your cloak again." He put his hand inside his cloak again, and when he took it out of his cloak, behold, it had

^{iv}"Gershom" sounds like the Hebrew for "an alien there".

^vWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

turned again as his other flesh. ⁸“It will happen, if they will not believe you or listen to the voice of the first sign, that they will believe the voice of the latter sign. ⁹It will happen, if they will not believe even these two signs or listen to your voice, that you shall take of the water of the river, and pour it on the dry land. The water which you take out of the river will become blood on the dry land.” ¹⁰Moses said to the LORD, “O Lord, ^{vi} I am not eloquent, neither before now, nor since you have spoken to your servant; for I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.” ¹¹The LORD said to him, “Who made man’s mouth? Or who makes one mute, or deaf, or seeing, or blind? Isn’t it I, the LORD? ¹²Now therefore go, and I will be with your mouth, and teach you what you shall speak.” ¹³Moses said, “Oh, Lord, please send someone else.” ¹⁴The LORD’s anger burned against Moses, and he said, “What about Aaron, your brother, the Levite? I know that he can speak well. Also, behold, he is coming out to meet you. When he sees you, he will be glad in his heart. ¹⁵You shall speak to him, and put the words in his mouth. I will be with your mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what you shall do. ¹⁶He will be your spokesman to the people. It will happen that he will be to you a mouth, and you will be to him as God. ¹⁷You shall take this rod in your hand, with which you shall do the signs.” ¹⁸Moses went and returned to Jethro his father-in-law, and said to him, “Please let me go and return to my brothers who are in Egypt, and see whether they are still alive.” Jethro said to Moses, “Go in peace.” ¹⁹The LORD said to Moses in Midian, “Go, return into Egypt; for all the men who sought your life are dead.” ²⁰Moses took his wife and his sons, and set them on a donkey, and he returned to the land of Egypt. Moses took God’s rod in his hand. ²¹The LORD said to Moses, “When you go back into Egypt, see that you do before Pharaoh all the wonders which I have put in your hand, but I will harden his heart and he will not let the people go. ²²You shall tell Pharaoh, ‘The LORD says, Israel is my son, my firstborn, ²³and I have said to you, “Let my son go, that he may serve me;” and you have refused to let him go. Behold, I will kill your firstborn son.’” ²⁴On the way at a lodging place, the LORD met Moses and wanted to kill him. ²⁵Then Zipporah took a flint, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet; and she said, “Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me.” ²⁶So he let him alone. Then she said, “You are a bridegroom of blood,” because of the circumcision. ²⁷The LORD said to Aaron, “Go into the wilderness to meet Moses.” He went, and met him on God’s mountain, and kissed him. ²⁸Moses told Aaron all the LORD’s words with which he had sent him, and all the signs with which he had instructed him. ²⁹Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel. ³⁰Aaron spoke all the words which the LORD had spoken to Moses, and did the signs in

the sight of the people. ³¹The people believed, and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel, and that he had seen their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshiped.

5Afterward Moses and Aaron came, and said to Pharaoh, “This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says, ‘Let my people go, that they may hold a feast to me in the wilderness.’” ²Pharaoh said, “Who is the LORD, that I should listen to his voice to let Israel go? I don’t know the LORD, and moreover I will not let Israel go.” ³They said, “The God of the Hebrews has met with us. Please let us go three days’ journey into the wilderness, and sacrifice to the LORD, our God, lest he fall on us with pestilence, or with the sword.” ⁴The king of Egypt said to them, “Why do you, Moses and Aaron, take the people from their work? Get back to your burdens!” ⁵Pharaoh said, “Behold, the people of the land are now many, and you make them rest from their burdens.” ⁶The same day Pharaoh commanded the taskmasters of the people and their officers, saying, ⁷“You shall no longer give the people straw to make brick, as before. Let them go and gather straw for themselves. ⁸You shall require from them the number of the bricks which they made before. You shall not diminish anything of it, for they are idle. Therefore they cry, saying, ‘Let’s go and sacrifice to our God.’ ⁹Let heavier work be laid on the men, that they may labor in it. Don’t let them pay any attention to lying words.” ¹⁰The taskmasters of the people went out with their officers, and they spoke to the people, saying, “This is what Pharaoh says: ‘I will not give you straw. ¹¹Go yourselves, get straw where you can find it, for nothing of your work shall be diminished.’” ¹²So the people were scattered abroad throughout all the land of Egypt to gather stubble for straw. ¹³The taskmasters were urgent saying, “Fulfill your work quota daily, as when there was straw!” ¹⁴The officers of the children of Israel, whom Pharaoh’s taskmasters had set over them, were beaten, and were asked, “Why haven’t you fulfilled your quota both yesterday and today, in making brick as before?” ¹⁵Then the officers of the children of Israel came and cried to Pharaoh, saying, “Why do you deal this way with your servants? ¹⁶No straw is given to your servants, and they tell us, ‘Make brick!’ and behold, your servants are beaten; but the fault is in your own people.” ¹⁷But Pharaoh said, “You are idle! You are idle! Therefore you say, ‘Let’s go and sacrifice to the LORD.’ ¹⁸Go therefore now, and work; for no straw shall be given to you; yet you shall deliver the same number of bricks!” ¹⁹The officers of the children of Israel saw that they were in trouble when it was said, “You shall not diminish anything from your daily quota of bricks!” ²⁰They met Moses and Aaron, who stood along the way, as they came out from Pharaoh. ²¹They said to them, “May the LORD look at you and judge, because you have made us a stench to be abhorred in the

^{vi}The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai”.

eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of his servants, to put a sword in their hand to kill us!" ²²Moses returned to the LORD, and said, "Lord, why have you brought trouble on this people? Why is it that you have sent me? ²³For since I came to Pharaoh to speak in your name, he has brought trouble on this people. You have not rescued your people at all!"

⁶The LORD said to Moses, "Now you shall see what I will do to Pharaoh, for by a strong hand he shall let them go, and by a strong hand he shall drive them out of his land." ²God spoke to Moses, and said to him, "I am the LORD. ³I appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, as God Almighty; but by my name the LORD I was not known to them. ⁴I have also established my covenant with them, to give them the land of Canaan, the land of their travels, in which they lived as aliens. ⁵Moreover I have heard the groaning of the children of Israel, whom the Egyptians keep in bondage, and I have remembered my covenant. ⁶Therefore tell the children of Israel, 'I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I will rid you out of their bondage, and I will redeem you with an outstretched arm, and with great judgments. ⁷I will take you to myself for a people. I will be your God; and you shall know that I am the LORD your God, who brings you out from under the burdens of the Egyptians. ⁸I will bring you into the land which I swore to give to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob; and I will give it to you for a heritage: I am the LORD.'" ⁹Moses spoke so to the children of Israel, but they didn't listen to Moses for anguish of spirit, and for cruel bondage. ¹⁰The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹¹"Go in, speak to Pharaoh king of Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land." ¹²Moses spoke before the LORD, saying, "Behold, the children of Israel haven't listened to me. How then shall Pharaoh listen to me, when I have uncircumcised lips?" ¹³The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, and gave them a command to the children of Israel, and to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁴These are the heads of their fathers' houses. The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel: Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi; these are the families of Reuben. ¹⁵The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, and Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar, and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman; these are the families of Simeon. ¹⁶These are the names of the sons of Levi according to their generations: Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari; and the years of the life of Levi were one hundred thirty-seven years. ¹⁷The sons of Gershon: Libni and Shimei, according to their families. ¹⁸The sons of Kohath: Amram, and Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel; and the years of the life of Kohath were one hundred thirty-three years. ¹⁹The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to their generations. ²⁰Amram took Jochebed his

father's sister to himself as wife; and she bore him Aaron and Moses. The years of the life of Amram were one hundred thirty-seven years. ²¹The sons of Izhar: Korah, and Nepheg, and Zichri. ²²The sons of Uzziel: Mishael, Elzaphan, and Sithri. ²³Aaron took Elisheba, the daughter of Amminadab, the sister of Nahshon, as his wife; and she bore him Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar. ²⁴The sons of Korah: Assir, Elkanah, and Abiasaph; these are the families of the Korahites. ²⁵Eleazar Aaron's son took one of the daughters of Putiel as his wife; and she bore him Phinehas. These are the heads of the fathers' houses of the Levites according to their families. ²⁶These are that Aaron and Moses to whom the LORD said, "Bring out the children of Israel from the land of Egypt according to their armies." ²⁷These are those who spoke to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring out the children of Israel from Egypt. These are that Moses and Aaron. ²⁸On the day when the LORD spoke to Moses in the land of Egypt, ²⁹The LORD said to Moses, "I am the LORD. Tell Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I tell you." ³⁰Moses said before the LORD, "Behold, I am of uncircumcised lips, and how shall Pharaoh listen to me?"

⁷The LORD said to Moses, "Behold, I have made you as God to Pharaoh; and Aaron your brother shall be your prophet. ²You shall speak all that I command you; and Aaron your brother shall speak to Pharaoh, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land. ³I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and multiply my signs and my wonders in the land of Egypt. ⁴But Pharaoh will not listen to you, so I will lay my hand on Egypt, and bring out my armies, my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great judgments. ⁵The Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD when I stretch out my hand on Egypt, and bring the children of Israel out from among them." ⁶Moses and Aaron did so. As the LORD commanded them, so they did. ⁷Moses was eighty years old, and Aaron eighty-three years old, when they spoke to Pharaoh. ⁸The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ⁹"When Pharaoh speaks to you, saying, 'Perform a miracle!' then you shall tell Aaron, 'Take your rod, and cast it down before Pharaoh, and it will become a serpent.'" ¹⁰Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh, and they did so, as the LORD had commanded. Aaron cast down his rod before Pharaoh and before his servants, and it became a serpent. ¹¹Then Pharaoh also called for the wise men and the sorcerers. They also, the magicians of Egypt, did the same thing with their enchantments. ¹²For they each cast down their rods, and they became serpents; but Aaron's rod swallowed up their rods. ¹³Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he didn't listen to them, as the LORD had spoken. ¹⁴The LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh's heart is stubborn. He refuses to let the people go. ¹⁵Go to Pharaoh in the morning. Behold, he is going out to the water. You shall stand by the river's bank

to meet him. You shall take the rod which was turned to a serpent in your hand. ¹⁶You shall tell him, ‘The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has sent me to you, saying, “Let my people go, that they may serve me in the wilderness. Behold, until now you haven’t listened.”’ ¹⁷The LORD says, “In this you shall know that I am the LORD. Behold: I will strike with the rod that is in my hand on the waters which are in the river, and they shall be turned to blood. ¹⁸The fish that are in the river will die and the river will become foul. The Egyptians will loathe to drink water from the river.”’ ¹⁹The LORD said to Moses, “Tell Aaron, ‘Take your rod, and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt, over their rivers, over their streams, and over their pools, and over all their ponds of water, that they may become blood. There will be blood throughout all the land of Egypt, both in vessels of wood and in vessels of stone.’” ²⁰Moses and Aaron did so, as the LORD commanded; and he lifted up the rod, and struck the waters that were in the river, in the sight of Pharaoh, and in the sight of his servants; and all the waters that were in the river were turned to blood. ²¹The fish that were in the river died. The river became foul. The Egyptians couldn’t drink water from the river. The blood was throughout all the land of Egypt. ²²The magicians of Egypt did the same thing with their enchantments. So Pharaoh’s heart was hardened, and he didn’t listen to them, as the LORD had spoken. ²³Pharaoh turned and went into his house, and he didn’t even take this to heart. ²⁴All the Egyptians dug around the river for water to drink; for they couldn’t drink the river water. ²⁵Seven days were fulfilled, after the LORD had struck the river.

⁸The LORD spoke to Moses, “Go in to Pharaoh, and tell him, ‘This is what the LORD says, “Let my people go, that they may serve me. ²If you refuse to let them go, behold, I will plague all your borders with frogs. ³The river will swarm with frogs, which will go up and come into your house, and into your bedroom, and on your bed, and into the house of your servants, and on your people, and into your ovens, and into your kneading troughs. ⁴The frogs shall come up both on you, and on your people, and on all your servants.”’” ⁵The LORD said to Moses, “Tell Aaron, ‘Stretch out your hand with your rod over the rivers, over the streams, and over the pools, and cause frogs to come up on the land of Egypt.’” ⁶Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt; and the frogs came up, and covered the land of Egypt. ⁷The magicians did the same thing with their enchantments, and brought up frogs on the land of Egypt. ⁸Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron, and said, “Entreat the LORD, that he take away the frogs from me and from my people; and I will let the people go, that they may sacrifice to the LORD.” ⁹Moses said to Pharaoh, “I give you the honor of setting the time that I should pray for you, and for your servants, and for your people, that the

frogs be destroyed from you and your houses, and remain in the river only.” ¹⁰Pharaoh said, “Tomorrow.” Moses said, “Let it be according to your word, that you may know that there is no one like the LORD our God. ¹¹The frogs shall depart from you, and from your houses, and from your servants, and from your people. They shall remain in the river only.” ¹²Moses and Aaron went out from Pharaoh, and Moses cried to the LORD concerning the frogs which he had brought on Pharaoh. ¹³The LORD did according to the word of Moses, and the frogs died out of the houses, out of the courts, and out of the fields. ¹⁴They gathered them together in heaps, and the land stank. ¹⁵But when Pharaoh saw that there was a respite, he hardened his heart, and didn’t listen to them, as the LORD had spoken. ¹⁶The LORD said to Moses, “Tell Aaron, ‘Stretch out your rod, and strike the dust of the earth, that it may become lice throughout all the land of Egypt.’” ¹⁷They did so; and Aaron stretched out his hand with his rod, and struck the dust of the earth, and there were lice on man, and on animal; all the dust of the earth became lice throughout all the land of Egypt. ¹⁸The magicians tried with their enchantments to produce lice, but they couldn’t. There were lice on man, and on animal. ¹⁹Then the magicians said to Pharaoh, “This is God’s finger;” but Pharaoh’s heart was hardened, and he didn’t listen to them, as the LORD had spoken. ²⁰The LORD said to Moses, “Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh; behold, he comes out to the water; and tell him, ‘This is what the LORD says, “Let my people go, that they may serve me. ²¹Else, if you will not let my people go, behold, I will send swarms of flies on you, and on your servants, and on your people, and into your houses. The houses of the Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies, and also the ground they are on. ²²I will set apart in that day the land of Goshen, in which my people dwell, that no swarms of flies shall be there, to the end you may know that I am the LORD on the earth. ²³I will put a division between my people and your people. This sign shall happen by tomorrow.”’” ²⁴The LORD did so; and there came grievous swarms of flies into the house of Pharaoh, and into his servants’ houses. In all the land of Egypt the land was corrupted by reason of the swarms of flies. ²⁵Pharaoh called for Moses and for Aaron, and said, “Go, sacrifice to your God in the land!” ²⁶Moses said, “It isn’t appropriate to do so; for we shall sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians to the LORD our God. Behold, if we sacrifice the abomination of the Egyptians before their eyes, won’t they stone us? ²⁷We will go three days’ journey into the wilderness, and sacrifice to the LORD our God, as he shall command us.” ²⁸Pharaoh said, “I will let you go, that you may sacrifice to the LORD your God in the wilderness, only you shall not go very far away. Pray for me.” ²⁹Moses said, “Behold, I am going out from you. I will pray to the LORD that the swarms of flies may depart from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his

people, tomorrow; only don't let Pharaoh deal deceitfully any more in not letting the people go to sacrifice to the LORD." ³⁰Moses went out from Pharaoh, and prayed to the LORD. ³¹The LORD did according to the word of Moses, and he removed the swarms of flies from Pharaoh, from his servants, and from his people. There remained not one. ³²Pharaoh hardened his heart this time also, and he didn't let the people go.

⁹Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go in to Pharaoh, and tell him, 'This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: "Let my people go, that they may serve me. ²For if you refuse to let them go, and hold them still, ³behold, the LORD's hand is on your livestock which are in the field, on the horses, on the donkeys, on the camels, on the herds, and on the flocks with a very grievous pestilence. ⁴The LORD will make a distinction between the livestock of Israel and the livestock of Egypt; and nothing shall die of all that belongs to the children of Israel.'" ⁵The LORD appointed a set time, saying, "Tomorrow the LORD shall do this thing in the land." ⁶The LORD did that thing on the next day; and all the livestock of Egypt died, but of the livestock of the children of Israel, not one died. ⁷Pharaoh sent, and, behold, there was not so much as one of the livestock of the Israelites dead. But the heart of Pharaoh was stubborn, and he didn't let the people go. ⁸The LORD said to Moses and to Aaron, "Take handfuls of ashes of the furnace, and let Moses sprinkle it toward the sky in the sight of Pharaoh. ⁹It shall become small dust over all the land of Egypt, and shall be boils and blisters breaking out on man and on animal, throughout all the land of Egypt." ¹⁰They took ashes of the furnace, and stood before Pharaoh; and Moses sprinkled it up toward the sky; and it became boils and blisters breaking out on man and on animal. ¹¹The magicians couldn't stand before Moses because of the boils; for the boils were on the magicians and on all the Egyptians. ¹²The LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh, and he didn't listen to them, as the LORD had spoken to Moses. ¹³The LORD said to Moses, "Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh, and tell him, 'This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: "Let my people go, that they may serve me. ¹⁴For this time I will send all my plagues against your heart, against your officials, and against your people; that you may know that there is no one like me in all the earth. ¹⁵For now I would have stretched out my hand, and struck you and your people with pestilence, and you would have been cut off from the earth; ¹⁶but indeed for this cause I have made you stand: to show you my power, and that my name may be declared throughout all the earth, ¹⁷because you still exalt yourself against my people, that you won't let them go. ¹⁸Behold, tomorrow about this time I will cause it to rain a very grievous hail, such as has not been in Egypt since the day it was founded

even until now. ¹⁹Now therefore command that all of your livestock and all that you have in the field be brought into shelter. The hail will come down on every man and animal that is found in the field, and isn't brought home, and they will die.'" ²⁰Those who feared the LORD's word among the servants of Pharaoh made their servants and their livestock flee into the houses. ²¹Whoever didn't respect the LORD's word left his servants and his livestock in the field. ²²The LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward the sky, that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt, on man, and on animal, and on every herb of the field, throughout the land of Egypt." ²³Moses stretched out his rod toward the heavens, and the LORD sent thunder and hail; and lightning flashed down to the earth. The LORD rained hail on the land of Egypt. ²⁴So there was very severe hail, and lightning mixed with the hail, such as had not been in all the land of Egypt since it became a nation. ²⁵The hail struck throughout all the land of Egypt all that was in the field, both man and animal; and the hail struck every herb of the field, and broke every tree of the field. ²⁶Only in the land of Goshen, where the children of Israel were, there was no hail. ²⁷Pharaoh sent and called for Moses and Aaron, and said to them, "I have sinned this time. The LORD is righteous, and I and my people are wicked. ²⁸Pray to the LORD; for there has been enough of mighty thunderings and hail. I will let you go, and you shall stay no longer." ²⁹Moses said to him, "As soon as I have gone out of the city, I will spread out my hands to the LORD. The thunders shall cease, and there will not be any more hail; that you may know that the earth is the LORD's. ³⁰But as for you and your servants, I know that you don't yet fear the LORD God." ³¹The flax and the barley were struck, for the barley had ripened and the flax was blooming. ³²But the wheat and the spelt were not struck, for they had not grown up. ³³Moses went out of the city from Pharaoh, and spread out his hands to the LORD; and the thunders and hail ceased, and the rain was not poured on the earth. ³⁴When Pharaoh saw that the rain and the hail and the thunders had ceased, he sinned yet more, and hardened his heart, he and his servants. ³⁵The heart of Pharaoh was hardened, and he didn't let the children of Israel go, just as the LORD had spoken through Moses.

¹⁰The LORD said to Moses, "Go in to Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart and the heart of his servants, that I may show these my signs among them; ²and that you may tell in the hearing of your son, and of your son's son, what things I have done to Egypt, and my signs which I have done among them; that you may know that I am the LORD." ³Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh, and said to him, "This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'How long will you refuse to humble yourself before me? Let my people go, that they may serve me. ⁴Or

else, if you refuse to let my people go, behold, tomorrow I will bring locusts into your country, ⁵and they shall cover the surface of the earth, so that one won't be able to see the earth. They shall eat the residue of that which has escaped, which remains to you from the hail, and shall eat every tree which grows for you out of the field. ⁶Your houses shall be filled, and the houses of all your servants, and the houses of all the Egyptians, as neither your fathers nor your fathers' fathers have seen, since the day that they were on the earth to this day.' He turned, and went out from Pharaoh. ⁷Pharaoh's servants said to him, "How long will this man be a snare to us? Let the men go, that they may serve the LORD, their God. Don't you yet know that Egypt is destroyed?" ⁸Moses and Aaron were brought again to Pharaoh, and he said to them, "Go, serve the LORD your God; but who are those who will go?" ⁹Moses said, "We will go with our young and with our old. We will go with our sons and with our daughters, with our flocks and with our herds; for we must hold a feast to the LORD." ¹⁰He said to them, "The LORD be with you if I let you go with your little ones! See, evil is clearly before your faces. ¹¹Not so! Go now you who are men, and serve the LORD; for that is what you desire!" Then they were driven out from Pharaoh's presence. ¹²The LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the land of Egypt for the locusts, that they may come up on the land of Egypt, and eat every herb of the land, even all that the hail has left." ¹³Moses stretched out his rod over the land of Egypt, and the LORD brought an east wind on the land all that day, and all night; and when it was morning, the east wind brought the locusts. ¹⁴The locusts went up over all the land of Egypt, and rested in all the borders of Egypt. They were very grievous. Before them there were no such locusts as they, nor will there ever be again. ¹⁵For they covered the surface of the whole earth, so that the land was darkened, and they ate every herb of the land, and all the fruit of the trees which the hail had left. There remained nothing green, either tree or herb of the field, through all the land of Egypt. ¹⁶Then Pharaoh called for Moses and Aaron in haste, and he said, "I have sinned against the LORD your God, and against you. ¹⁷Now therefore please forgive my sin again, and pray to the LORD your God, that he may also take away from me this death." ¹⁸Moses went out from Pharaoh, and prayed to the LORD. ¹⁹The LORD sent an exceedingly strong west wind, which took up the locusts, and drove them into the Sea of Suf. ^{vii} There remained not one locust in all the borders of Egypt. ²⁰But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he didn't let the children of Israel go. ²¹The LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward the sky, that there may be

darkness over the land of Egypt, even darkness which may be felt." ²²Moses stretched out his hand toward the sky, and there was a thick darkness in all the land of Egypt for three days. ²³They didn't see one another, and nobody rose from his place for three days; but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings. ²⁴Pharaoh called to Moses, and said, "Go, serve the LORD. Only let your flocks and your herds stay behind. Let your little ones also go with you." ²⁵Moses said, "You must also give into our hand sacrifices and burnt offerings, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God. ²⁶Our livestock also shall go with us. Not a hoof shall be left behind, for of it we must take to serve the LORD our God; and we don't know with what we must serve the LORD, until we come there." ²⁷But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he wouldn't let them go. ²⁸Pharaoh said to him, "Get away from me! Be careful to see my face no more; for in the day you see my face you shall die!" ²⁹Moses said, "You have spoken well. I will see your face again no more."

11 The LORD said to Moses, "I will bring yet one more plague on Pharaoh, and on Egypt; afterwards he will let you go. When he lets you go, he will surely thrust you out altogether. ²Speak now in the ears of the people, and let every man ask of his neighbor, and every woman of her neighbor, jewels of silver, and jewels of gold." ³The LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians. Moreover, the man Moses was very great in the land of Egypt, in the sight of Pharaoh's servants, and in the sight of the people. ⁴Moses said, "This is what the LORD says: 'About midnight I will go out into the middle of Egypt, ⁵and all the firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne, even to the firstborn of the female servant who is behind the mill, and all the firstborn of livestock. ⁶There will be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as there has not been, nor will be any more. ⁷But against any of the children of Israel a dog won't even bark or move its tongue, against man or animal, that you may know that the LORD makes a distinction between the Egyptians and Israel. ⁸All these servants of yours will come down to me, and bow down themselves to me, saying, "Get out, with all the people who follow you;" and after that I will go out.'" He went out from Pharaoh in hot anger. ⁹The LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh won't listen to you, that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt." ¹⁰Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh, but the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he didn't let the children of Israel go out of his land.

12 The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying, ²"This month shall be to you the beginning of months. It shall be the first month of the year to you. ³Speak to all the congregation of Israel, saying, 'On the

^{vii}"Sea of Suf" is the translation for the Hebrew "Yam Suf", which could be more literally translated "Sea of Reeds" or "Sea of Cattails". It refers to the body of water currently known as the Sea of Suf, or possibly to one of the bodies of water connected to it or near it.

tenth day of this month, they shall take to them every man a lamb, according to their fathers' houses, a lamb for a household; ⁴and if the household is too little for a lamb, then he and his neighbor next to his house shall take one according to the number of the souls. You shall make your count for the lamb according to what everyone can eat. ⁵Your lamb shall be without defect, a male a year old. You shall take it from the sheep or from the goats. ⁶You shall keep it until the fourteenth day of the same month; and the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it at evening. ⁷They shall take some of the blood, and put it on the two door posts and on the lintel, on the houses in which they shall eat it. ⁸They shall eat the meat in that night, roasted with fire, with unleavened bread. They shall eat it with bitter herbs. ⁹Don't eat it raw, nor boiled at all with water, but roasted with fire; with its head, its legs and its inner parts. ¹⁰You shall let nothing of it remain until the morning; but that which remains of it until the morning you shall burn with fire. ¹¹This is how you shall eat it: with your belt on your waist, your sandals on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and you shall eat it in haste: it is the LORD's Passover. ¹²For I will go through the land of Egypt in that night, and will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and animal. I will execute judgments against all the gods of Egypt. I am the LORD. ¹³The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt. ¹⁴This day shall be a memorial for you. You shall keep it as a feast to the LORD. You shall keep it as a feast throughout your generations by an ordinance forever. ¹⁵"Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread; even the first day you shall put away yeast out of your houses, for whoever eats leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel. ¹⁶In the first day there shall be to you a holy convocation, and in the seventh day a holy convocation; no kind of work shall be done in them, except that which every man must eat, only that may be done by you. ¹⁷You shall observe the feast of unleavened bread; for in this same day I have brought your armies out of the land of Egypt. Therefore you shall observe this day throughout your generations by an ordinance forever. ¹⁸In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at evening, you shall eat unleavened bread, until the twenty first day of the month at evening. ¹⁹There shall be no yeast found in your houses for seven days, for whoever eats that which is leavened, that soul shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether he is a foreigner, or one who is born in the land. ²⁰You shall eat nothing leavened. In all your habitations you shall eat unleavened bread." ²¹Then Moses called for all the elders of Israel, and said to them, "Draw out, and take lambs according to your families, and kill the Passover. ²²You shall take a bunch

of hyssop, and dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and strike the lintel and the two door posts with the blood that is in the basin. None of you shall go out of the door of his house until the morning. ²³For the LORD will pass through to strike the Egyptians; and when he sees the blood on the lintel, and on the two door posts, the LORD will pass over the door, and will not allow the destroyer to come in to your houses to strike you. ²⁴You shall observe this thing for an ordinance to you and to your sons forever. ²⁵It shall happen when you have come to the land which the LORD will give you, as he has promised, that you shall keep this service. ²⁶It will happen, when your children ask you, 'What do you mean by this service?' ²⁷that you shall say, 'It is the sacrifice of the LORD's Passover, who passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, when he struck the Egyptians, and spared our houses.'" The people bowed their heads and worshiped. ²⁸The children of Israel went and did so; as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did. ²⁹At midnight, the LORD struck all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sat on his throne to the firstborn of the captive who was in the dungeon, and all the firstborn of livestock. ³⁰Pharaoh rose up in the night, he, and all his servants, and all the Egyptians; and there was a great cry in Egypt, for there was not a house where there was not one dead. ³¹He called for Moses and Aaron by night, and said, "Rise up, get out from among my people, both you and the children of Israel; and go, serve the LORD, as you have said! ³²Take both your flocks and your herds, as you have said, and be gone; and bless me also!" ³³The Egyptians were urgent with the people, to send them out of the land in haste, for they said, "We are all dead men." ³⁴The people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneading troughs being bound up in their clothes on their shoulders. ³⁵The children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they asked of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and clothing. ³⁶The LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they let them have what they asked. They plundered the Egyptians. ³⁷The children of Israel traveled from Rameses to Succoth, about six hundred thousand on foot who were men, in addition to children. ³⁸A mixed multitude went up also with them, with flocks, herds, and even very much livestock. ³⁹They baked unleavened cakes of the dough which they brought out of Egypt; for it wasn't leavened, because they were thrust out of Egypt, and couldn't wait, and they had not prepared any food for themselves. ⁴⁰Now the time that the children of Israel lived in Egypt was four hundred thirty years. ⁴¹At the end of four hundred thirty years, to the day, all of the LORD's armies went out from the land of Egypt. ⁴²It is a night to be much observed to the LORD for bringing them out from the land of Egypt. This is that night of the LORD, to be much observed by all the children of Israel throughout their generations. ⁴³The

LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the ordinance of the Passover. No foreigner shall eat of it, ⁴⁴but every man's servant who is bought for money, when you have circumcised him, then shall he eat of it. ⁴⁵A foreigner and a hired servant shall not eat of it. ⁴⁶It must be eaten in one house. You shall not carry any of the meat outside of the house. Do not break any of its bones. ⁴⁷All the congregation of Israel shall keep it. ⁴⁸When a stranger lives as a foreigner with you, and would like to keep the Passover to the LORD, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it. He shall be as one who is born in the land; but no uncircumcised person shall eat of it. ⁴⁹One law shall be to him who is born at home, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you." ⁵⁰All the children of Israel did so. As the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did. ⁵¹That same day, the LORD brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their armies.

13The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Sanctify to me all the firstborn, whatever opens the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of animal. It is mine." ³Moses said to the people, "Remember this day, in which you came out of Egypt, out of the house of bondage; for by strength of hand the LORD brought you out from this place. No leavened bread shall be eaten. ⁴Today you go out in the month Abib. ⁵It shall be, when the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Amorite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite, which he swore to your fathers to give you, a land flowing with milk and honey, that you shall keep this service in this month. ⁶Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, and in the seventh day shall be a feast to the LORD. ⁷Unleavened bread shall be eaten throughout the seven days; and no leavened bread shall be seen with you. No yeast shall be seen with you, within all your borders. ⁸You shall tell your son in that day, saying, 'It is because of that which the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.' ⁹It shall be for a sign to you on your hand, and for a memorial between your eyes, that the LORD's law may be in your mouth; for with a strong hand the LORD has brought you out of Egypt. ¹⁰You shall therefore keep this ordinance in its season from year to year. ¹¹"It shall be, when the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanite, as he swore to you and to your fathers, and will give it you, ¹²that you shall set apart to the LORD all that opens the womb, and every firstborn that comes from an animal which you have. The males shall be the LORD's. ¹³Every firstborn of a donkey you shall redeem with a lamb; and if you will not redeem it, then you shall break its neck; and you shall redeem all the firstborn of man among your sons. ¹⁴It shall be, when your son asks you in time to come, saying, 'What is this?' that you shall tell him, 'By strength of hand the LORD brought us out from Egypt, from the

house of bondage. ¹⁵When Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of livestock. Therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that opens the womb, being males; but all the firstborn of my sons I redeem.' ¹⁶It shall be for a sign on your hand, and for symbols between your eyes; for by strength of hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt." ¹⁷When Pharaoh had let the people go, God didn't lead them by the way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near; for God said, "Lest perhaps the people change their minds when they see war, and they return to Egypt"; ¹⁸but God led the people around by the way of the wilderness by the Sea of Suf; and the children of Israel went up armed out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁹Moses took the bones of Joseph with him, for he had made the children of Israel swear, saying, "God will surely visit you, and you shall carry up my bones away from here with you." ²⁰They took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness. ²¹The LORD went before them by day in a pillar of cloud, to lead them on their way, and by night in a pillar of fire, to give them light, that they might go by day and by night: ²²the pillar of cloud by day, and the pillar of fire by night, didn't depart from before the people.

14The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Speak to the children of Israel, that they turn back and encamp before Pihahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, before Baal Zephon. You shall encamp opposite it by the sea. ³Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel, 'They are entangled in the land. The wilderness has shut them in.' ⁴I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and he will follow after them; and I will get honor over Pharaoh, and over all his armies; and the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD." They did so. ⁵The king of Egypt was told that the people had fled; and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was changed toward the people, and they said, "What is this we have done, that we have let Israel go from serving us?" ⁶He prepared his chariot, and took his army with him; ⁷and he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, with captains over all of them. ⁸The LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued the children of Israel; for the children of Israel went out with a high hand. ^{viii} ⁹The Egyptians pursued them. All the horses and chariots of Pharaoh, his horsemen, and his army overtook them encamping by the sea, beside Pihahiroth, before Baal Zephon. ¹⁰When Pharaoh came near, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and behold, the Egyptians were marching after them; and they were very afraid. The children of Israel cried out to the LORD. ¹¹They said to Moses, "Because there were no graves in Egypt, have you taken us away to die in the wilderness? Why have you

^{viii}or, defiantly.

treated us this way, to bring us out of Egypt? ¹²Isn't this the word that we spoke to you in Egypt, saying, 'Leave us alone, that we may serve the Egyptians?' For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in the wilderness." ¹³Moses said to the people, "Don't be afraid. Stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today; for you will never again see the Egyptians whom you have seen today. ¹⁴The LORD will fight for you, and you shall be still." ¹⁵The LORD said to Moses, "Why do you cry to me? Speak to the children of Israel, that they go forward. ¹⁶Lift up your rod, and stretch out your hand over the sea and divide it. Then the children of Israel shall go into the middle of the sea on dry ground. ¹⁷Behold, I myself will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they will go in after them. I will get myself honor over Pharaoh, and over all his armies, over his chariots, and over his horsemen. ¹⁸The Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD when I have gotten myself honor over Pharaoh, over his chariots, and over his horsemen." ¹⁹The angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, moved and went behind them; and the pillar of cloud moved from before them, and stood behind them. ²⁰It came between the camp of Egypt and the camp of Israel. There was the cloud and the darkness, yet it gave light by night. One didn't come near the other all night. ²¹Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided. ²²The children of Israel went into the middle of the sea on the dry ground; and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. ²³The Egyptians pursued, and went in after them into the middle of the sea: all of Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen. ²⁴In the morning watch, the LORD looked out on the Egyptian army through the pillar of fire and of cloud, and confused the Egyptian army. ²⁵He took off their chariot wheels, and they drove them heavily; so that the Egyptians said, "Let's flee from the face of Israel, for the LORD fights for them against the Egyptians!" ²⁶The LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the waters may come again on the Egyptians, on their chariots, and on their horsemen." ²⁷Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to its strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it. The LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the middle of the sea. ²⁸The waters returned, and covered the chariots and the horsemen, even all Pharaoh's army that went in after them into the sea. There remained not so much as one of them. ²⁹But the children of Israel walked on dry land in the middle of the sea, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. ³⁰Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore. ³¹Israel saw the great work which the LORD did to the Egyptians, and the people feared the LORD; and

they believed in the LORD and in his servant Moses.

¹⁵Then Moses and the children of Israel sang this song to the LORD, and said, "I will sing to the LORD, for he has triumphed gloriously. He has thrown the horse and his rider into the sea. ²The LORD is my strength and song. He has become my salvation [yeshu'ah]. This is my God, and I will praise him; my father's God, and I will exalt him. ³The LORD is a man of war. The LORD is his name. ⁴He has cast Pharaoh's chariots and his army into the sea. His chosen captains are sunk in the Sea of Suf. ⁵The deeps cover them. They went down into the depths like a stone. ⁶Your right hand, LORD, is glorious in power. Your right hand, LORD, dashes the enemy in pieces. ⁷In the greatness of your excellency, you overthrow those who rise up against you. You send out your wrath. It consumes them as stubble. ⁸With the blast of your nostrils, the waters were piled up. The floods stood upright as a heap. The deeps were congealed in the heart of the sea. ⁹The enemy said, 'I will pursue. I will overtake. I will divide the plunder. My desire will be satisfied on them. I will draw my sword. My hand will destroy them.' ¹⁰You blew with your wind. The sea covered them. They sank like lead in the mighty waters. ¹¹Who is like you, LORD, among the gods? Who is like you, glorious in holiness, fearful in praises, doing wonders? ¹²You stretched out your right hand. The earth swallowed them. ¹³"You, in your loving kindness, have led the people that you have redeemed. You have guided them in your strength to your holy habitation. ¹⁴The peoples have heard. They tremble. Pangs have taken hold of the inhabitants of Philistia. ¹⁵Then the chiefs of Edom were dismayed. Trembling takes hold of the mighty men of Moab. All the inhabitants of Canaan have melted away. ¹⁶Terror and dread falls on them. By the greatness of your arm they are as still as a stone, until your people pass over, LORD, until the people you have purchased pass over. ¹⁷You will bring them in, and plant them in the mountain of your inheritance, the place, LORD, which you have made for yourself to dwell in: the sanctuary, Lord, which your hands have established. ¹⁸The LORD will reign forever and ever." ¹⁹For the horses of Pharaoh went in with his chariots and with his horsemen into the sea, and the LORD brought back the waters of the sea on them; but the children of Israel walked on dry land in the middle of the sea. ²⁰Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a tambourine in her hand; and all the women went out after her with tambourines and with dances. ²¹Miriam answered them, "Sing to the LORD, for he has triumphed gloriously. He has thrown the horse and his rider into the sea." ²²Moses led Israel onward from the Sea of Suf, and they went out into the wilderness of Shur; and they went three days in the wilderness, and found no water. ²³When they came to Marah, they couldn't drink from the waters of Marah, for they were bitter. Therefore

its name was called Marah.^{ix} ²⁴The people murmured against Moses, saying, “What shall we drink?” ²⁵Then he cried to the LORD. The LORD showed him a tree, and he threw it into the waters, and the waters were made sweet. There he made a statute and an ordinance for them, and there he tested them. ²⁶He said, “If you will diligently listen to the LORD your God’s voice, and will do that which is right in his eyes, and will pay attention to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of the diseases on you which I have put on the Egyptians; for I am the LORD who heals you.” ²⁷They came to Elim, where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees. They encamped there by the waters.

16They took their journey from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came to the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt. ²The whole congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron in the wilderness; ³and the children of Israel said to them, “We wish that we had died by the LORD’s hand in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the meat pots, when we ate our fill of bread, for you have brought us out into this wilderness to kill this whole assembly with hunger.” ⁴Then the LORD said to Moses, “Behold, I will rain bread from the sky for you, and the people shall go out and gather a day’s portion every day, that I may test them, whether they will walk in my law or not. ⁵It shall come to pass on the sixth day, that they shall prepare that which they bring in, and it shall be twice as much as they gather daily.” ⁶Moses and Aaron said to all the children of Israel, “At evening, you shall know that the LORD has brought you out from the land of Egypt. ⁷In the morning, you shall see the LORD’s glory; because he hears your murmurings against the LORD. Who are we, that you murmur against us?” ⁸Moses said, “Now the LORD will give you meat to eat in the evening, and in the morning bread to satisfy you, because the LORD hears your murmurings which you murmur against him. And who are we? Your murmurings are not against us, but against the LORD.” ⁹Moses said to Aaron, “Tell all the congregation of the children of Israel, ‘Come close to the LORD, for he has heard your murmurings.’” ¹⁰As Aaron spoke to the whole congregation of the children of Israel, they looked toward the wilderness, and behold, the LORD’s glory appeared in the cloud. ¹¹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹²“I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel. Speak to them, saying, ‘At evening you shall eat meat, and in the morning you shall be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God.’” ¹³In the evening, quail came up and covered the camp; and in the morning the dew lay around the camp. ¹⁴When the dew that lay had gone, be-

hold, on the surface of the wilderness was a small round thing, small as the frost on the ground. ¹⁵When the children of Israel saw it, they said to one another, “What is it?” For they didn’t know what it was. Moses said to them, “It is the bread which the LORD has given you to eat. ¹⁶This is the thing which the LORD has commanded: ‘Gather of it everyone according to his eating; an omer^x a head, according to the number of your persons, you shall take it, every man for those who are in his tent.’” ¹⁷The children of Israel did so, and some gathered more, some less. ¹⁸When they measured it with an omer, he who gathered much had nothing over, and he who gathered little had no lack. They each gathered according to his eating. ¹⁹Moses said to them, “Let no one leave of it until the morning.” ²⁰Notwithstanding they didn’t listen to Moses, but some of them left of it until the morning, so it bred worms and became foul; and Moses was angry with them. ²¹They gathered it morning by morning, everyone according to his eating. When the sun grew hot, it melted. ²²On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for each one; and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses. ²³He said to them, “This is that which the LORD has spoken, ‘Tomorrow is a solemn rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. Bake that which you want to bake, and boil that which you want to boil; and all that remains over lay up for yourselves to be kept until the morning.’” ²⁴They laid it up until the morning, as Moses ordered, and it didn’t become foul, and there were no worms in it. ²⁵Moses said, “Eat that today, for today is a Sabbath to the LORD. Today you shall not find it in the field. ²⁶Six days you shall gather it, but on the seventh day is the Sabbath. In it there shall be none.” ²⁷On the seventh day, some of the people went out to gather, and they found none. ²⁸The LORD said to Moses, “How long do you refuse to keep my commandments and my laws? ²⁹Behold, because the LORD has given you the Sabbath, therefore he gives you on the sixth day the bread of two days. Everyone stay in his place. Let no one go out of his place on the seventh day.” ³⁰So the people rested on the seventh day. ³¹The house of Israel called its name “Manna”,^{xi} and it was like coriander seed, white; and its taste was like wafers with honey. ³²Moses said, “This is the thing which the LORD has commanded, ‘Let an omer-full of it be kept throughout your generations, that they may see the bread with which I fed you in the wilderness, when I brought you out of the land of Egypt.’” ³³Moses said to Aaron, “Take a pot, and put an omer-full of manna in it, and lay it up before the LORD, to be kept throughout your generations.” ³⁴As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to be kept. ³⁵The children of Israel ate the manna forty years, until they came to an inhabited land. They ate the manna until they came to the borders

^{ix}Marah means bitter.

^xAn omer is about 2.2 liters or about 2.3 quarts

^{xi}“Manna” means “What is it?”

of the land of Canaan. ³⁶Now an omer is one tenth of an efah. ^{xii}

17All the congregation of the children of Israel traveled from the wilderness of Sin, starting according to the LORD's commandment, and encamped in Rephidim; but there was no water for the people to drink. ²Therefore the people quarreled with Moses, and said, "Give us water to drink." Moses said to them, "Why do you quarrel with me? Why do you test the LORD?" ³The people were thirsty for water there; so the people murmured against Moses, and said, "Why have you brought us up out of Egypt, to kill us, our children, and our livestock with thirst?" ⁴Moses cried to the LORD, saying, "What shall I do with these people? They are almost ready to stone me." ⁵The LORD said to Moses, "Walk on before the people, and take the elders of Israel with you, and take the rod in your hand with which you struck the Nile, and go. ⁶Behold, I will stand before you there on the rock in Horeb. You shall strike the rock, and water will come out of it, that the people may drink." Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel. ⁷He called the name of the place Massah, ^{xiii} and Meribah, ^{xiv} because the children of Israel quarreled, and because they tested the LORD, saying, "Is the LORD among us, or not?" ⁸Then Amalek came and fought with Israel in Rephidim. ⁹Moses said to Joshua, "Choose men for us, and go out to fight with Amalek. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with God's rod in my hand." ¹⁰So Joshua did as Moses had told him, and fought with Amalek; and Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. ¹¹When Moses held up his hand, Israel prevailed. When he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed. ¹²But Moses' hands were heavy; so they took a stone, and put it under him, and he sat on it. Aaron and Hur held up his hands, the one on the one side, and the other on the other side. His hands were steady until sunset. ¹³Joshua defeated Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword. ¹⁴The LORD said to Moses, "Write this for a memorial in a book, and rehearse it in the ears of Joshua: that I will utterly blot out the memory of Amalek from under the sky." ¹⁵Moses built an altar, and called its name "The LORD our Banner". ^{xv} ¹⁶He said, "The LORD has sworn: 'The LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.'"

18Now Jethro, the priest of Midian, Moses' father-in-law, heard of all that God had done for Moses and for Israel his people, how the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt. ²Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, received Zipporah, Moses' wife, after he had sent her away, ³and her two sons.

The name of one son was Gershom, ^{xvi} for Moses said, "I have lived as a foreigner in a foreign land". ⁴The name of the other was Eliezer, ^{xvii} for he said, "My father's God was my help and delivered me from Pharaoh's sword." ⁵Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, came with Moses' sons and his wife to Moses into the wilderness where he was encamped, at the Mountain of God. ⁶He said to Moses, "I, your father-in-law Jethro, have come to you with your wife, and her two sons with her." ⁷Moses went out to meet his father-in-law, and bowed and kissed him. They asked each other of their welfare, and they came into the tent. ⁸Moses told his father-in-law all that the LORD had done to Pharaoh and to the Egyptians for Israel's sake, all the hardships that had come on them on the way, and how the LORD delivered them. ⁹Jethro rejoiced for all the goodness which the LORD had done to Israel, in that he had delivered them out of the hand of the Egyptians. ¹⁰Jethro said, "Blessed be the LORD, who has delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of Pharaoh; who has delivered the people from under the hand of the Egyptians. ¹¹Now I know that the LORD is greater than all gods because of the way that they treated people arrogantly." ¹²Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, took a burnt offering and sacrifices for God. Aaron came with all the elders of Israel, to eat bread with Moses' father-in-law before God. ¹³On the next day, Moses sat to judge the people, and the people stood around Moses from the morning to the evening. ¹⁴When Moses' father-in-law saw all that he did to the people, he said, "What is this thing that you do for the people? Why do you sit alone, and all the people stand around you from morning to evening?" ¹⁵Moses said to his father-in-law, "Because the people come to me to inquire of God. ¹⁶When they have a matter, they come to me, and I judge between a man and his neighbor, and I make them know the statutes of God, and his laws." ¹⁷Moses' father-in-law said to him, "The thing that you do is not good. ¹⁸You will surely wear away, both you, and this people that is with you; for the thing is too heavy for you. You are not able to perform it yourself alone. ¹⁹Listen now to my voice. I will give you counsel, and God be with you. You represent the people before God, and bring the causes to God. ²⁰You shall teach them the statutes and the laws, and shall show them the way in which they must walk, and the work that they must do. ²¹Moreover you shall provide out of all the people able men which fear God: men of truth, hating unjust gain; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens. ²²Let them judge the people at all times. It shall be that every great matter they shall bring to you, but every small matter they shall judge themselves. So shall it be easier for you, and they shall share the load with you. ²³If you will do this thing, and God commands you so, then

^{xii}1 efah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xiii}Massah means testing.

^{xiv}Meribah means quarreling.

^{xv}Hebrew, YahwehNissi

^{xvi}"Gershom" sounds like the Hebrew for "an alien there".

^{xvii}Eliezer means "God is my helper".

you will be able to endure, and all these people also will go to their place in peace.”²⁴ So Moses listened to the voice of his father-in-law, and did all that he had said.²⁵ Moses chose able men out of all Israel, and made them heads over the people, rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens.²⁶ They judged the people at all times. They brought the hard cases to Moses, but every small matter they judged themselves.²⁷ Moses let his father-in-law depart, and he went his way into his own land.

19 In the third month after the children of Israel had gone out of the land of Egypt, on that same day they came into the wilderness of Sinai.² When they had departed from Rephidim, and had come to the wilderness of Sinai, they encamped in the wilderness; and there Israel encamped before the mountain.³ Moses went up to God, and the LORD called to him out of the mountain, saying, “This is what you shall tell the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel: ⁴‘You have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles’ wings, and brought you to myself. ⁵Now therefore, if you will indeed obey my voice and keep my covenant, then you shall be my own possession from among all peoples; for all the earth is mine; ⁶and you shall be to me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.’ These are the words which you shall speak to the children of Israel.”⁷ Moses came and called for the elders of the people, and set before them all these words which the LORD commanded him.⁸ All the people answered together, and said, “All that the LORD has spoken we will do.” Moses reported the words of the people to the LORD.⁹ The LORD said to Moses, “Behold, I come to you in a thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with you, and may also believe you forever.” Moses told the words of the people to the LORD.¹⁰ The LORD said to Moses, “Go to the people, and sanctify them today and tomorrow, and let them wash their garments,¹¹ and be ready for the third day; for on the third day the LORD will come down in the sight of all the people on Mount Sinai.¹² You shall set bounds to the people all around, saying, ‘Be careful that you don’t go up onto the mountain, or touch its border. Whoever touches the mountain shall be surely put to death.¹³ No hand shall touch him, but he shall surely be stoned or shot through; whether it is animal or man, he shall not live.’ When the shofar sounds long, they shall come up to the mountain.”¹⁴ Moses went down from the mountain to the people, and sanctified the people; and they washed their clothes.¹⁵ He said to the people, “Be ready by the third day. Don’t have sexual relations with a woman.”¹⁶ On the third day, when it was morning, there were thunders and lightnings, and a thick cloud on the mountain, and the sound of an exceedingly loud shofar; and all the people who were in the camp trembled.¹⁷ Moses led the people out of the camp to meet God;

and they stood at the lower part of the mountain.¹⁸ All of Mount Sinai smoked, because the LORD descended on it in fire; and its smoke ascended like the smoke of a furnace, and the whole mountain quaked greatly.¹⁹ When the sound of the shofar grew louder and louder, Moses spoke, and God answered him by a voice.²⁰ The LORD came down on Mount Sinai, to the top of the mountain. The LORD called Moses to the top of the mountain, and Moses went up.²¹ The LORD said to Moses, “Go down, warn the people, lest they break through to the LORD to gaze, and many of them perish.²² Let the priests also, who come near to the LORD, sanctify themselves, lest the LORD break out on them.”²³ Moses said to the LORD, “The people can’t come up to Mount Sinai, for you warned us, saying, ‘Set bounds around the mountain, and sanctify it.’”²⁴ The LORD said to him, “Go down! You shall bring Aaron up with you, but don’t let the priests and the people break through to come up to the LORD, lest he break out against them.”²⁵ So Moses went down to the people, and told them.

20 God^{xviii} spoke all these words, saying, ²“I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ³“You shall have no other gods before me. ⁴“You shall not make for yourselves an idol, nor any image of anything that is in the heavens above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth: ⁵you shall not bow yourself down to them, nor serve them, for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, on the third and on the fourth generation of those who hate me, ⁶and showing loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments. ⁷“You shall not misuse the name of the LORD your God,^{xix} for the LORD will not hold him guiltless who misuses his name. ⁸“Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy. ⁹You shall labor six days, and do all your work,¹⁰ but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God. You shall not do any work in it, you, nor your son, nor your daughter, your male servant, nor your female servant, nor your livestock, nor your stranger who is within your gates; ¹¹for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, and rested the seventh day; therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day, and made it holy. ¹²“Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land which the LORD your God gives you. ¹³“You shall not murder. ¹⁴“You shall not commit adultery. ¹⁵“You shall not steal. ¹⁶“You shall not give false testimony against your neighbor. ¹⁷“You shall not covet your neighbor’s house. You shall not covet your neighbor’s

^{xviii}After “God”, the Hebrew has the two letters “Aleph Tav” (the first and last letters of the Hebrew alphabet), not as a word, but as a grammatical marker.

^{xix}or, You shall not take the name of Yahweh your God in vain

wife, nor his male servant, nor his female servant, nor his ox, nor his donkey, nor anything that is your neighbor's."

¹⁸All the people perceived the thunderings, the lightnings, the sound of the shofar, and the mountain smoking. When the people saw it, they trembled, and stayed at a distance.

¹⁹They said to Moses, "Speak with us yourself, and we will listen; but don't let God speak with us, lest we die."

²⁰Moses said to the people, "Don't be afraid, for God has come to test you, and that his fear may be before you, that you won't sin."

²¹The people stayed at a distance, and Moses came near to the thick darkness where God was. ²²The LORD said to Moses, "This is what you shall tell the children of Israel: 'You yourselves have seen that I have talked with you from heaven. ²³You shall most certainly not make gods of silver or gods of gold for yourselves to be alongside me. ²⁴You shall make an altar of earth for me, and shall sacrifice on it your burnt offerings and your peace offerings, your sheep and your cattle. In every place where I record my name I will come to you and I will bless you. ²⁵If you make me an altar of stone, you shall not build it of cut stones; for if you lift up your tool on it, you have polluted it. ²⁶You shall not go up by steps to my altar, that your nakedness may not be exposed to it.'

²¹Now these are the ordinances which you shall set before them: ²"If you buy a Hebrew servant, he shall serve six years, and in the seventh he shall go out free without paying anything. ³If he comes in by himself, he shall go out by himself. If he is married, then his wife shall go out with him. ⁴If his master gives him a wife and she bears him sons or daughters, the wife and her children shall be her master's, and he shall go out by himself. ⁵But if the servant shall plainly say, 'I love my master, my wife, and my children. I will not go out free;' ⁶then his master shall bring him to God, and shall bring him to the door or to the doorpost, and his master shall bore his ear through with an awl, and he shall serve him forever. ⁷"If a man sells his daughter to be a female servant, she shall not go out as the male servants do. ⁸If she doesn't please her master, who has married her to himself, then he shall let her be redeemed. He shall have no right to sell her to a foreign people, since he has dealt deceitfully with her. ⁹If he marries her to his son, he shall deal with her as a daughter. ¹⁰If he takes another wife to himself, he shall not diminish her food, her clothing, and her marital rights. ¹¹If he doesn't do these three things for her, she may go free without paying any money. ¹²"One who strikes a man so that he dies shall surely be put to death, ¹³but not if it is unintentional, but God allows it to happen; then I will appoint you a place where he shall flee. ¹⁴If a man schemes and comes presumptuously on his neighbor to kill him, you shall take him from my altar, that he may die. ¹⁵"Anyone who attacks his father or his mother shall be surely put to death. ¹⁶"Anyone who kidnaps someone and

sells him, or if he is found in his hand, he shall surely be put to death. ¹⁷"Anyone who curses his father or his mother shall surely be put to death. ¹⁸"If men quarrel and one strikes the other with a stone, or with his fist, and he doesn't die, but is confined to bed; ¹⁹if he rises again and walks around with his staff, then he who struck him shall be cleared; only he shall pay for the loss of his time, and shall provide for his healing until he is thoroughly healed. ²⁰"If a man strikes his servant or his maid with a rod, and he dies under his hand, the man shall surely be punished. ²¹Notwithstanding, if his servant gets up after a day or two, he shall not be punished, for the servant is his property. ²²"If men fight and hurt a pregnant woman so that she gives birth prematurely, and yet no harm follows, he shall be surely fined as much as the woman's husband demands and the judges allow. ²³But if any harm follows, then you must take life for life, ²⁴eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot, ²⁵burning for burning, wound for wound, and bruise for bruise. ²⁶"If a man strikes his servant's eye, or his maid's eye, and destroys it, he shall let him go free for his eye's sake. ²⁷If he strikes out his male servant's tooth, or his female servant's tooth, he shall let the servant go free for his tooth's sake. ²⁸"If a bull gores a man or a woman to death, the bull shall surely be stoned, and its meat shall not be eaten; but the owner of the bull shall not be held responsible. ²⁹But if the bull had a habit of goring in the past, and this has been testified to its owner, and he has not kept it in, but it has killed a man or a woman, the bull shall be stoned, and its owner shall also be put to death. ³⁰If a ransom is imposed on him, then he shall give for the redemption of his life whatever is imposed. ³¹Whether it has gored a son or has gored a daughter, according to this judgment it shall be done to him. ³²If the bull gores a male servant or a female servant, thirty shekels ^{xx} of silver shall be given to their master, and the ox shall be stoned. ³³"If a man opens a pit, or if a man digs a pit and doesn't cover it, and a bull or a donkey falls into it, ³⁴the owner of the pit shall make it good. He shall give money to its owner, and the dead animal shall be his. ³⁵"If one man's bull injures another's, so that it dies, then they shall sell the live bull, and divide its price; and they shall also divide the dead animal. ³⁶Or if it is known that the bull was in the habit of goring in the past, and its owner has not kept it in, he shall surely pay bull for bull, and the dead animal shall be his own.

²²"If a man steals an ox or a sheep, and kills it or sells it, he shall pay five oxen for an ox, and four sheep for a sheep. ²If the thief is found breaking in, and is struck so that he dies, there shall be no guilt of bloodshed for him. ³If the sun has risen on him, he is guilty of bloodshed. He shall make restitution. If he has nothing, then he shall

^{xx}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 30 shekels is about 300 grams or about 10.6 ounces.

be sold for his theft. ⁴If the stolen property is found in his hand alive, whether it is ox, donkey, or sheep, he shall pay double. ⁵"If a man causes a field or vineyard to be eaten by letting his animal loose, and it grazes in another man's field, he shall make restitution from the best of his own field, and from the best of his own vineyard. ⁶"If fire breaks out, and catches in thorns so that the shocks of grain, or the standing grain, or the field are consumed; he who kindled the fire shall surely make restitution. ⁷"If a man delivers to his neighbor money or stuff to keep, and it is stolen out of the man's house, if the thief is found, he shall pay double. ⁸If the thief isn't found, then the master of the house shall come near to God, to find out whether or not he has put his hand on his neighbor's goods. ⁹For every matter of trespass, whether it is for ox, for donkey, for sheep, for clothing, or for any kind of lost thing, about which one says, 'This is mine,' the cause of both parties shall come before God. He whom God condemns shall pay double to his neighbor. ¹⁰"If a man delivers to his neighbor a donkey, an ox, a sheep, or any animal to keep, and it dies or is injured, or driven away, no man seeing it; ¹¹the oath of the LORD shall be between them both, he has not put his hand on his neighbor's goods; and its owner shall accept it, and he shall not make restitution. ¹²But if it is stolen from him, the one who stole shall make restitution to its owner. ¹³If it is torn in pieces, let him bring it for evidence. He shall not make good that which was torn. ¹⁴"If a man borrows anything of his neighbor's, and it is injured, or dies, its owner not being with it, he shall surely make restitution. ¹⁵If its owner is with it, he shall not make it good. If it is a leased thing, it came for its lease. ¹⁶"If a man entices a virgin who isn't pledged to be married, and lies with her, he shall surely pay a dowry for her to be his wife. ¹⁷If her father utterly refuses to give her to him, he shall pay money according to the dowry of virgins. ¹⁸"You shall not allow a sorceress to live. ¹⁹"Whoever has sex with an animal shall surely be put to death. ²⁰"He who sacrifices to any god, except to the LORD only, shall be utterly destroyed. ²¹"You shall not wrong an alien or oppress him, for you were aliens in the land of Egypt. ²²"You shall not take advantage of any widow or fatherless child. ²³If you take advantage of them at all, and they cry at all to me, I will surely hear their cry; ²⁴and my wrath will grow hot, and I will kill you with the sword; and your wives shall be widows, and your children fatherless. ²⁵"If you lend money to any of my people with you who is poor, you shall not be to him as a creditor. You shall not charge him interest. ²⁶If you take your neighbor's garment as collateral, you shall restore it to him before the sun goes down, ²⁷for that is his only covering, it is his garment for his skin. What would he sleep in? It will happen, when he cries to me, that I will hear, for I am gracious. ²⁸"You shall not blaspheme God, nor curse a ruler of your people. ²⁹"You shall not

delay to offer from your harvest and from the outflow of your presses. "You shall give the firstborn of your sons to me. ³⁰You shall do likewise with your cattle and with your sheep. It shall be with its mother seven days, then on the eighth day you shall give it to me. ³¹"You shall be holy men to me, therefore you shall not eat any meat that is torn by animals in the field. You shall cast it to the dogs.

23"You shall not spread a false report. Don't join your hand with the wicked to be a malicious witness. ²"You shall not follow a crowd to do evil. You shall not testify in court to side with a multitude to pervert justice. ³You shall not favor a poor man in his cause. ⁴"If you meet your enemy's ox or his donkey going astray, you shall surely bring it back to him again. ⁵If you see the donkey of him who hates you fallen down under his burden, don't leave him. You shall surely help him with it. ⁶"You shall not deny justice to your poor people in their lawsuits. ⁷"Keep far from a false charge, and don't kill the innocent and righteous; for I will not justify the wicked. ⁸"You shall take no bribe, for a bribe blinds those who have sight and perverts the words of the righteous. ⁹"You shall not oppress an alien, for you know the heart of an alien, since you were aliens in the land of Egypt. ¹⁰"For six years you shall sow your land, and shall gather in its increase, ¹¹but the seventh year you shall let it rest and lie fallow, that the poor of your people may eat; and what they leave the animal of the field shall eat. In the same way, you shall deal with your vineyard and with your olive grove. ¹²"Six days you shall do your work, and on the seventh day you shall rest, that your ox and your donkey may have rest, and the son of your servant, and the alien may be refreshed. ¹³"Be careful to do all things that I have said to you; and don't invoke the name of other gods or even let them be heard out of your mouth. ¹⁴"You shall observe a feast to me three times a year. ¹⁵You shall observe the feast of unleavened bread. Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, as I commanded you, at the time appointed in the month Abib (for in it you came out of Egypt), and no one shall appear before me empty. ¹⁶And the feast of harvest, the first fruits of your labors, which you sow in the field; and the feast of ingathering, at the end of the year, when you gather in your labors out of the field. ¹⁷Three times in the year all your males shall appear before the Lord GOD. ¹⁸"You shall not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leavened bread. The fat of my feast shall not remain all night until the morning. ¹⁹You shall bring the first of the first fruits of your ground into the house of the LORD your God. "You shall not boil a young goat in its mother's milk. ²⁰"Behold, I send an angel before you, to keep you by the way, and to bring you into the place which I have prepared. ²¹Pay attention to him, and listen to his voice. Don't provoke him, for he will not pardon your disobedience, for my name is in him. ²²But if you indeed listen to his voice,

and do all that I speak, then I will be an enemy to your enemies, and an adversary to your adversaries. ²³For my angel shall go before you, and bring you in to the Amorite, the Hittite, the Perizzite, the Canaanite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite; and I will cut them off. ²⁴You shall not bow down to their gods, nor serve them, nor follow their practices, but you shall utterly overthrow them and demolish their pillars. ²⁵You shall serve the LORD your God, and he will bless your bread and your water, and I will take sickness away from among you. ²⁶No one will miscarry or be barren in your land. I will fulfill the number of your days. ²⁷I will send my terror before you, and will confuse all the people to whom you come, and I will make all your enemies turn their backs to you. ²⁸I will send the hornet before you, which will drive out the Hivite, the Canaanite, and the Hittite, from before you. ²⁹I will not drive them out from before you in one year, lest the land become desolate, and the animals of the field multiply against you. ³⁰Little by little I will drive them out from before you, until you have increased and inherit the land. ³¹I will set your border from the Sea of Suf even to the sea of the Philistines, and from the wilderness to the River; for I will deliver the inhabitants of the land into your hand, and you shall drive them out before you. ³²You shall make no covenant with them, nor with their gods. ³³They shall not dwell in your land, lest they make you sin against me, for if you serve their gods, it will surely be a snare to you.”

²⁴He said to Moses, “Come up to the LORD, you, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel; and worship from a distance. ²Moses alone shall come near to the LORD, but they shall not come near. The people shall not go up with him.” ³Moses came and told the people all the LORD’s words, and all the ordinances; and all the people answered with one voice, and said, “All the words which the LORD has spoken will we do.” ⁴Moses wrote all the LORD’s words, then rose up early in the morning and built an altar at the base of the mountain, with twelve pillars for the twelve tribes of Israel. ⁵He sent young men of the children of Israel, who offered burnt offerings and sacrificed peace offerings of cattle to the LORD. ⁶Moses took half of the blood and put it in basins, and half of the blood he sprinkled on the altar. ⁷He took the book of the covenant and read it in the hearing of the people, and they said, “We will do all that the LORD has said, and be obedient.” ⁸Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it on the people, and said, “Look, this is the blood of the covenant, which the LORD has made with you concerning all these words.” ⁹Then Moses, Aaron, Nadab, Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel went up. ¹⁰They saw the God of Israel. Under his feet was like a paved work of sapphire ^{xxi} stone, like the skies for clearness. ¹¹He didn’t lay his hand on the nobles of the children of Israel.

They saw God, and ate and drank. ¹²The LORD said to Moses, “Come up to me on the mountain, and stay here, and I will give you the stone tablets with the law and the commands that I have written, that you may teach them.” ¹³Moses rose up with Joshua, his servant, and Moses went up onto God’s Mountain. ¹⁴He said to the elders, “Wait here for us, until we come again to you. Behold, Aaron and Hur are with you. Whoever is involved in a dispute can go to them.” ¹⁵Moses went up on the mountain, and the cloud covered the mountain. ¹⁶The LORD’s glory settled on Mount Sinai, and the cloud covered it six days. The seventh day he called to Moses out of the middle of the cloud. ¹⁷The appearance of the LORD’s glory was like devouring fire on the top of the mountain in the eyes of the children of Israel. ¹⁸Moses entered into the middle of the cloud, and went up on the mountain; and Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

²⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, that they take an offering for me. From everyone whose heart makes him willing you shall take my offering. ³This is the offering which you shall take from them: gold, silver, bronze, ⁴blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats’ hair, ⁵rams’ skins dyed red, sea cow hides, ^{xxii} acacia wood, ⁶oil for the light, spices for the anointing oil and for the sweet incense, ⁷onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate. ⁸Let them make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell among them. ⁹According to all that I show you, the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all of its furniture, even so you shall make it. ¹⁰“They shall make an ark of acacia wood. Its length shall be two and a half cubits, ^{xxiii} its width a cubit and a half, and a cubit and a half its height. ¹¹You shall overlay it with pure gold. You shall overlay it inside and outside, and you shall make a gold molding around it. ¹²You shall cast four rings of gold for it, and put them in its four feet. Two rings shall be on the one side of it, and two rings on the other side of it. ¹³You shall make poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold. ¹⁴You shall put the poles into the rings on the sides of the ark to carry the ark. ¹⁵The poles shall be in the rings of the ark. They shall not be taken from it. ¹⁶You shall put the covenant which I shall give you into the ark. ¹⁷You shall make a mercy seat of pure gold. Two and a half cubits shall be its length, and a cubit and a half its width. ¹⁸You shall make two cherubim of hammered gold. You shall make them at the two ends of the mercy seat. ¹⁹Make one cherub at the one end, and one cherub at the other end. You shall make the cherubim on its two ends of one piece with the mercy seat. ²⁰The cherubim shall spread out their wings upward, covering the mercy seat with their wings, with their faces

^{xxii}or, fine leather

^{xxiii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xxi}or, lapis lazuli

toward one another. The faces of the cherubim shall be toward the mercy seat. ²¹You shall put the mercy seat on top of the ark, and in the ark you shall put the covenant that I will give you. ²²There I will meet with you, and I will tell you from above the mercy seat, from between the two cherubim which are on the ark of the covenant, all that I command you for the children of Israel. ²³"You shall make a table of acacia wood. Its length shall be two cubits, and its width a cubit, and its height one and a half cubits. ²⁴You shall overlay it with pure gold, and make a gold molding around it. ²⁵You shall make a rim of a hand width around it. You shall make a golden molding on its rim around it. ²⁶You shall make four rings of gold for it, and put the rings in the four corners that are on its four feet. ²⁷The rings shall be close to the rim, for places for the poles to carry the table. ²⁸You shall make the poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold, that the table may be carried with them. ²⁹You shall make its dishes, its spoons, its ladles, and its bowls with which to pour out offerings. You shall make them of pure gold. ³⁰You shall set bread of the presence on the table before me always. ³¹"You shall make a lamp stand of pure gold. The lamp stand shall be made of hammered work. Its base, its shaft, its cups, its buds, and its flowers shall be of one piece with it. ³²There shall be six branches going out of its sides: three branches of the lamp stand out of its one side, and three branches of the lamp stand out of its other side; ³³three cups made like almond blossoms in one branch, a bud and a flower; and three cups made like almond blossoms in the other branch, a bud and a flower, so for the six branches going out of the lamp stand; ³⁴and in the lamp stand four cups made like almond blossoms, its buds and its flowers; ³⁵and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, for the six branches going out of the lamp stand. ³⁶Their buds and their branches shall be of one piece with it, all of it one beaten work of pure gold. ³⁷You shall make its lamps seven, and they shall light its lamps to give light to the space in front of it. ³⁸Its snuffers and its snuff dishes shall be of pure gold. ³⁹It shall be made of a talent ^{xxiv} of pure gold, with all these accessories. ⁴⁰See that you make them after their pattern, which has been shown to you on the mountain.

26"Moreover you shall make the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet, with cherubim. You shall make them with the work of a skillful workman. ²The length of each curtain shall be twenty-eight cubits, ^{xxv} and the width of each curtain four cubits: all the curtains shall have one measure. ³Five

curtains shall be coupled together to one another, and the other five curtains shall be coupled to one another. ⁴You shall make loops of blue on the edge of the one curtain from the edge in the coupling, and you shall do likewise on the edge of the curtain that is outermost in the second coupling. ⁵You shall make fifty loops in the one curtain, and you shall make fifty loops in the edge of the curtain that is in the second coupling. The loops shall be opposite one another. ⁶You shall make fifty clasps of gold, and couple the curtains to one another with the clasps. The tabernacle shall be a unit. ⁷"You shall make curtains of goats' hair for a covering over the tabernacle. You shall make eleven curtains. ⁸The length of each curtain shall be thirty cubits, and the width of each curtain four cubits: the eleven curtains shall have one measure. ⁹You shall couple five curtains by themselves, and six curtains by themselves, and shall double over the sixth curtain in the forefront of the tent. ¹⁰You shall make fifty loops on the edge of the one curtain that is outermost in the coupling, and fifty loops on the edge of the curtain which is outermost in the second coupling. ¹¹You shall make fifty clasps of bronze, and put the clasps into the loops, and couple the tent together, that it may be one. ¹²The overhanging part that remains of the curtains of the tent—the half curtain that remains—shall hang over the back of the tabernacle. ¹³The cubit on the one side and the cubit on the other side, of that which remains in the length of the curtains of the tent, shall hang over the sides of the tabernacle on this side and on that side, to cover it. ¹⁴You shall make a covering for the tent of rams' skins dyed red, and a covering of sea cow hides above. ¹⁵"You shall make the boards for the tabernacle of acacia wood, standing upright. ¹⁶Ten cubits shall be the length of a board, and one and a half cubits the width of each board. ¹⁷There shall be two tenons in each board, joined to one another: thus you shall make for all the boards of the tabernacle. ¹⁸You shall make twenty boards for the tabernacle, for the south side southward. ¹⁹You shall make forty sockets of silver under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for its two tenons, and two sockets under another board for its two tenons. ²⁰For the second side of the tabernacle, on the north side, twenty boards, ²¹and their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board. ²²For the far side of the tabernacle westward you shall make six boards. ²³You shall make two boards for the corners of the tabernacle in the far side. ²⁴They shall be double beneath, and in the same way they shall be whole to its top to one ring: thus shall it be for them both; they shall be for the two corners. ²⁵There shall be eight boards, and their sockets of silver, sixteen sockets; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board. ²⁶"You shall make bars of acacia wood: five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle, ²⁷and five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle,

^{xxiv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

^{xxv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

and five bars for the boards of the side of the tabernacle, for the far side westward. ²⁸The middle bar in the middle of the boards shall pass through from end to end. ²⁹You shall overlay the boards with gold, and make their rings of gold for places for the bars. You shall overlay the bars with gold. ³⁰You shall set up the tabernacle according to the way that it was shown to you on the mountain. ³¹"You shall make a veil of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, with cherubim. It shall be the work of a skillful workman. ³²You shall hang it on four pillars of acacia overlaid with gold; their hooks shall be of gold, on four sockets of silver. ³³You shall hang up the veil under the clasps, and shall bring the ark of the covenant in there within the veil. The veil shall separate the holy place from the most holy for you. ³⁴You shall put the mercy seat on the ark of the covenant in the most holy place. ³⁵You shall set the table outside the veil, and the lamp stand opposite the table on the side of the tabernacle toward the south. You shall put the table on the north side. ³⁶"You shall make a screen for the door of the Tent, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, the work of the embroiderer. ³⁷You shall make for the screen five pillars of acacia, and overlay them with gold. Their hooks shall be of gold. You shall cast five sockets of bronze for them.

27^{xxvi}"You shall make the altar of acacia wood, five cubits long, and five cubits wide. The altar shall be square. Its height shall be three cubits. ^{xxvii} ²You shall make its horns on its four corners. Its horns shall be of one piece with it. You shall overlay it with bronze. ³You shall make its pots to take away its ashes; and its shovels, its basins, its meat hooks, and its fire pans. You shall make all its vessels of bronze. ⁴You shall make a grating for it of network of bronze. On the net you shall make four bronze rings in its four corners. ⁵You shall put it under the ledge around the altar beneath, that the net may reach halfway up the altar. ⁶You shall make poles for the altar, poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with bronze. ⁷Its poles shall be put into the rings, and the poles shall be on the two sides of the altar when carrying it. ⁸You shall make it hollow with planks. They shall make it as it has been shown you on the mountain. ⁹"You shall make the court of the tabernacle: for the south side southward there shall be hangings for the court of fine twined linen one hundred cubits long for one side. ¹⁰Its pillars shall be twenty, and their sockets twenty, of bronze. The hooks of the pillars and their fillets shall be of silver. ¹¹Likewise for the length of the north side, there shall be hangings one hundred cubits long, and its pillars twenty, and their sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks of the pillars, and

their fillets, of silver. ¹²For the width of the court on the west side shall be hangings of fifty cubits; their pillars ten, and their sockets ten. ¹³The width of the court on the east side eastward shall be fifty cubits. ¹⁴The hangings for the one side of the gate shall be fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three. ¹⁵For the other side shall be hangings of fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three. ¹⁶For the gate of the court shall be a screen of twenty cubits, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, the work of the embroiderer; their pillars four, and their sockets four. ¹⁷All the pillars of the court around shall be filleted with silver; their hooks of silver, and their sockets of bronze. ¹⁸The length of the court shall be one hundred cubits, and the width fifty throughout, and the height five cubits, of fine twined linen, and their sockets of bronze. ¹⁹All the instruments of the tabernacle in all its service, and all its pins, and all the pins of the court, shall be of bronze. ²⁰"You shall command the children of Israel, that they bring to you pure olive oil beaten for the light, to cause a lamp to burn continually. ²¹In the Tent of Meeting, outside the veil which is before the covenant, Aaron and his sons shall keep it in order from evening to morning before the LORD: it shall be a statute forever throughout their generations on the behalf of the children of Israel.

28"Bring Aaron your brother, and his sons with him, near to you from among the children of Israel, that he may minister to me in the priest's office: Aaron, with Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar, Aaron's sons. ²You shall make holy garments for Aaron your brother, for glory and for beauty. ³You shall speak to all who are wise-hearted, whom I have filled with the spirit of wisdom, that they make Aaron's garments to sanctify him, that he may minister to me in the priest's office. ⁴These are the garments which they shall make: a breastplate, an ephod, a robe, a fitted tunic, a turban, and a sash. They shall make holy garments for Aaron your brother and his sons, that he may minister to me in the priest's office. ⁵They shall use the gold, and the blue, and the purple, and the scarlet, and the fine linen. ⁶"They shall make the ephod of gold, blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen, the work of the skillful workman. ⁷It shall have two shoulder straps joined to the two ends of it, that it may be joined together. ⁸The skillfully woven band, which is on it, shall be like its work and of the same piece; of gold, blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen. ⁹You shall take two onyx stones, and engrave on them the names of the children of Israel. ¹⁰Six of their names on the one stone, and the names of the six that remain on the other stone, in the order of their birth. ¹¹With the work of an engraver in stone, like the engravings of a signet, you shall engrave the two stones, according to the names of the children of Israel. You shall make them to be enclosed in settings of gold. ¹²You shall put the two

^{xxvi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xxvii}The altar was to be about 2.3×2.3×1.4 meters or about 7½×7½×4½ feet.

stones on the shoulder straps of the ephod, to be stones of memorial for the children of Israel. Aaron shall bear their names before the LORD on his two shoulders for a memorial. ¹³You shall make settings of gold, ¹⁴and two chains of pure gold; you shall make them like cords of braided work. You shall put the braided chains on the settings. ¹⁵“You shall make a breastplate of judgment, the work of the skillful workman; like the work of the ephod you shall make it; of gold, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, you shall make it. ¹⁶It shall be square and folded double; a span ^{xxviii} shall be its length, and a span its width. ¹⁷You shall set in it settings of stones, four rows of stones: a row of ruby, topaz, and beryl shall be the first row; ¹⁸and the second row a turquoise, a sapphire, ^{xxix} and an emerald; ¹⁹and the third row a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst; ²⁰and the fourth row a chrysolite, an onyx, and a jasper. They shall be enclosed in gold in their settings. ²¹The stones shall be according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names; like the engravings of a signet, everyone according to his name, they shall be for the twelve tribes. ²²You shall make on the breastplate chains like cords, of braided work of pure gold. ²³You shall make on the breastplate two rings of gold, and shall put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate. ²⁴You shall put the two braided chains of gold in the two rings at the ends of the breastplate. ²⁵The other two ends of the two braided chains you shall put on the two settings, and put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod in its forepart. ²⁶You shall make two rings of gold, and you shall put them on the two ends of the breastplate, on its edge, which is toward the side of the ephod inward. ²⁷You shall make two rings of gold, and shall put them on the two shoulder straps of the ephod underneath, in its forepart, close by its coupling, above the skillfully woven band of the ephod. ²⁸They shall bind the breastplate by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it may be on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, and that the breastplate may not swing out from the ephod. ²⁹Aaron shall bear the names of the children of Israel in the breastplate of judgment on his heart, when he goes in to the holy place, for a memorial before the LORD continually. ³⁰You shall put in the breastplate of judgment the Urim and the Thummim; and they shall be on Aaron’s heart, when he goes in before the LORD. Aaron shall bear the judgment of the children of Israel on his heart before the LORD continually. ³¹“You shall make the robe of the ephod all of blue. ³²It shall have a hole for the head in the middle of it. It shall have a binding of woven work around its hole, as it were the hole of a coat of mail, that it not be torn. ³³On its hem you shall make pomegranates of blue,

and of purple, and of scarlet, all around its hem; with bells of gold between and around them: ³⁴a golden bell and a pomegranate, a golden bell and a pomegranate, around the hem of the robe. ³⁵It shall be on Aaron to minister: and its sound shall be heard when he goes in to the holy place before the LORD, and when he comes out, that he not die. ³⁶“You shall make a plate of pure gold, and engrave on it, like the engravings of a signet, ‘HOLY TO THE LORD.’ ³⁷You shall put it on a lace of blue, and it shall be on the sash. It shall be on the front of the sash. ³⁸It shall be on Aaron’s forehead, and Aaron shall bear the iniquity of the holy things, which the children of Israel shall make holy in all their holy gifts; and it shall be always on his forehead, that they may be accepted before the LORD. ³⁹You shall weave the tunic with fine linen. You shall make a turban of fine linen. You shall make a sash, the work of the embroiderer. ⁴⁰“You shall make tunics for Aaron’s sons. You shall make sashes for them. You shall make headbands for them, for glory and for beauty. ⁴¹You shall put them on Aaron your brother, and on his sons with him, and shall anoint them, and consecrate them, and sanctify them, that they may minister to me in the priest’s office. ⁴²You shall make them linen pants to cover their naked flesh. They shall reach from the waist even to the thighs. ⁴³They shall be on Aaron and on his sons, when they go in to the Tent of Meeting, or when they come near to the altar to minister in the holy place, that they don’t bear iniquity, and die. This shall be a statute forever to him and to his offspring after him.

²⁹“This is the thing that you shall do to them to make them holy, to minister to me in the priest’s office: take one young bull and two rams without defect, ²unleavened bread, unleavened cakes mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed with oil. You shall make them of fine wheat flour. ³You shall put them into one basket, and bring them in the basket, with the bull and the two rams. ⁴You shall bring Aaron and his sons to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and shall wash them with water. ⁵You shall take the garments, and put on Aaron the tunic, the robe of the ephod, the ephod, and the breastplate, and clothe him with the skillfully woven band of the ephod. ⁶You shall set the turban on his head, and put the holy crown on the turban. ⁷Then you shall take the anointing oil, and pour it on his head, and anoint him. ⁸You shall bring his sons, and put tunics on them. ⁹You shall clothe them with belts, Aaron and his sons, and bind headbands on them. They shall have the priesthood by a perpetual statute. You shall consecrate Aaron and his sons. ¹⁰“You shall bring the bull before the Tent of Meeting; and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the bull. ¹¹You shall kill the bull before the LORD at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ¹²You shall take of the blood of the bull, and put it on the horns of the altar with your finger; and you shall pour out

^{xxviii}A span is the length from the tip of a man’s thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.)

^{xxix}or, lapis lazuli

all the blood at the base of the altar. ¹³You shall take all the fat that covers the innards, the cover of the liver, the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, and burn them on the altar. ¹⁴But the meat of the bull, and its skin, and its dung, you shall burn with fire outside of the camp. It is a sin offering. ¹⁵“You shall also take the one ram, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the ram. ¹⁶You shall kill the ram, and you shall take its blood, and sprinkle it around on the altar. ¹⁷You shall cut the ram into its pieces, and wash its innards, and its legs, and put them with its pieces, and with its head. ¹⁸You shall burn the whole ram on the altar: it is a burnt offering to the LORD; it is a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD. ¹⁹“You shall take the other ram, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on the head of the ram. ²⁰Then you shall kill the ram, and take some of its blood, and put it on the tip of the right ear of Aaron, and on the tip of the right ear of his sons, and on the thumb of their right hand, and on the big toe of their right foot; and sprinkle the blood around on the altar. ²¹You shall take of the blood that is on the altar, and of the anointing oil, and sprinkle it on Aaron, and on his garments, and on his sons, and on the garments of his sons with him: and he shall be made holy, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons’ garments with him. ²²Also you shall take some of the ram’s fat, the fat tail, the fat that covers the innards, the cover of the liver, the two kidneys, the fat that is on them, and the right thigh (for it is a ram of consecration), ²³and one loaf of bread, one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer out of the basket of unleavened bread that is before the LORD. ²⁴You shall put all of this in Aaron’s hands, and in his sons’ hands, and shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. ²⁵You shall take them from their hands, and burn them on the altar on the burnt offering, for a pleasant aroma before the LORD: it is an offering made by fire to the LORD. ²⁶“You shall take the breast of Aaron’s ram of consecration, and wave it for a wave offering before the LORD. It shall be your portion. ²⁷You shall sanctify the breast of the wave offering and the thigh of the wave offering, which is waved, and which is raised up, of the ram of consecration, even of that which is for Aaron, and of that which is for his sons. ²⁸It shall be for Aaron and his sons as their portion forever from the children of Israel; for it is a wave offering. It shall be a wave offering from the children of Israel of the sacrifices of their peace offerings, even their wave offering to the LORD. ²⁹“The holy garments of Aaron shall be for his sons after him, to be anointed in them, and to be consecrated in them. ³⁰Seven days shall the son who is priest in his place put them on, when he comes into the Tent of Meeting to minister in the holy place. ³¹“You shall take the ram of consecration and boil its meat in a holy place. ³²Aaron and his sons shall eat the meat of the ram, and the bread that is in the basket, at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ³³They

shall eat those things with which atonement was made, to consecrate and sanctify them; but a stranger shall not eat of it, because they are holy. ³⁴If anything of the meat of the consecration, or of the bread, remains to the morning, then you shall burn the remainder with fire. It shall not be eaten, because it is holy. ³⁵“You shall do so to Aaron and to his sons, according to all that I have commanded you. You shall consecrate them seven days. ³⁶Every day you shall offer the bull of sin offering for atonement. You shall cleanse the altar when you make atonement for it. You shall anoint it, to sanctify it. ³⁷Seven days you shall make atonement for the altar, and sanctify it; and the altar shall be most holy. Whatever touches the altar shall be holy. ³⁸“Now this is that which you shall offer on the altar: two lambs a year old day by day continually. ³⁹The one lamb you shall offer in the morning; and the other lamb you shall offer at evening; ⁴⁰and with the one lamb a tenth part of an ephah ^{xxx} of fine flour mixed with the fourth part of a hin ^{xxxi} of beaten oil, and the fourth part of a hin of wine for a drink offering. ⁴¹The other lamb you shall offer at evening, and shall do to it according to the meal offering of the morning and according to its drink offering, for a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD. ⁴²It shall be a continual burnt offering throughout your generations at the door of the Tent of Meeting before the LORD, where I will meet with you, to speak there to you. ⁴³There I will meet with the children of Israel; and the place shall be sanctified by my glory. ⁴⁴I will sanctify the Tent of Meeting and the altar. I will also sanctify Aaron and his sons to minister to me in the priest’s office. ⁴⁵I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will be their God. ⁴⁶They shall know that I am the LORD their God, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, that I might dwell among them: I am the LORD their God.

³⁰“You shall make an altar to burn incense on. You shall make it of acacia wood. ²Its length shall be a cubit, ^{xxxii} and its width a cubit. It shall be square, and its height shall be two cubits. Its horns shall be of one piece with it. ³You shall overlay it with pure gold, its top, its sides around it, and its horns; and you shall make a gold molding around it. ⁴You shall make two golden rings for it under its molding; on its two ribs, on its two sides you shall make them; and they shall be for places for poles with which to bear it. ⁵You shall make the poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold. ⁶You shall put it before the veil that is by the ark of the covenant, before the mercy seat that is over the covenant, where I will meet with you. ⁷Aaron shall burn incense of sweet spices on it

^{xxx}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxxi}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons, so a fourth of a hin is about 1.6 liters.

^{xxxii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

every morning. When he tends the lamps, he shall burn it.⁸ When Aaron lights the lamps at evening, he shall burn it, a perpetual incense before the LORD throughout your generations.⁹ You shall offer no strange incense on it, nor burnt offering, nor meal offering; and you shall pour no drink offering on it.¹⁰ Aaron shall make atonement on its horns once in the year; with the blood of the sin offering of atonement once in the year he shall make atonement for it throughout your generations. It is most holy to the LORD.”¹¹ The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,¹² “When you take a census of the children of Israel, according to those who are counted among them, then each man shall give a ransom for his soul to the LORD when you count them, that there be no plague among them when you count them.¹³ They shall give this, everyone who passes over to those who are counted, half a shekel according to the shekel^{xxxiii} of the sanctuary (the shekel is twenty gerahs^{xxxiv}); half a shekel for an offering to the LORD.¹⁴ Everyone who passes over to those who are counted, from twenty years old and upward, shall give the offering to the LORD.¹⁵ The rich shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less, than the half shekel,^{xxxv} when they give the offering of the LORD, to make atonement for your souls.¹⁶ You shall take the atonement money from the children of Israel, and shall appoint it for the service of the Tent of Meeting; that it may be a memorial for the children of Israel before the LORD, to make atonement for your souls.”¹⁷ The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,¹⁸ “You shall also make a basin of bronze, and its base of bronze, in which to wash. You shall put it between the Tent of Meeting and the altar, and you shall put water in it.¹⁹ Aaron and his sons shall wash their hands and their feet in it.²⁰ When they go into the Tent of Meeting, they shall wash with water, that they not die; or when they come near to the altar to minister, to burn an offering made by fire to the LORD.²¹ So they shall wash their hands and their feet, that they not die. This shall be a statute forever to them, even to him and to his descendants throughout their generations.”²² Moreover the LORD spoke to Moses, saying,²³ “Also take fine spices: of liquid myrrh, five hundred shekels;^{xxxvi} and of fragrant cinnamon half as much, even two hundred and fifty; and of fragrant cane, two hundred and fifty;²⁴ and of cassia five hundred, according to the shekel of the sanctuary; and a hin^{xxxvii} of olive oil.²⁵ You shall make it into a holy anointing oil, a perfume compounded after the art of the perfumer: it shall be a holy anointing oil.²⁶ You shall use it to anoint the Tent of Meeting, the ark of the covenant,²⁷ the table and all its articles, the lamp stand and its accessories, the altar

of incense,²⁸ the altar of burnt offering with all its utensils, and the basin with its base.²⁹ You shall sanctify them, that they may be most holy. Whatever touches them shall be holy.³⁰ You shall anoint Aaron and his sons, and sanctify them, that they may minister to me in the priest’s office.³¹ You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘This shall be a holy anointing oil to me throughout your generations.³² It shall not be poured on man’s flesh, and do not make any like it, according to its composition. It is holy. It shall be holy to you.³³ Whoever compounds any like it, or whoever puts any of it on a stranger, he shall be cut off from his people.’”³⁴ The LORD said to Moses, “Take to yourself sweet spices, gum resin, onycha, and galbanum: sweet spices with pure frankincense. There shall be an equal weight of each.³⁵ You shall make incense of it, a perfume after the art of the perfumer, seasoned with salt, pure and holy.³⁶ You shall beat some of it very small, and put some of it before the covenant in the Tent of Meeting, where I will meet with you. It shall be to you most holy.³⁷ You shall not make this incense, according to its composition, for yourselves: it shall be to you holy for the LORD.³⁸ Whoever shall make any like that, to smell of it, he shall be cut off from his people.”

31 The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,² “Behold, I have called by name Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah.³ I have filled him with the Spirit of God, in wisdom, and in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all kinds of workmanship,⁴ to devise skillful works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in bronze,⁵ and in cutting of stones for setting, and in carving of wood, to work in all kinds of workmanship.⁶ Behold, I myself have appointed with him Oholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan; and in the heart of all who are wise-hearted I have put wisdom, that they may make all that I have commanded you:⁷ the Tent of Meeting, the ark of the covenant, the mercy seat that is on it, all the furniture of the Tent,⁸ the table and its vessels, the pure lamp stand with all its vessels, the altar of incense,⁹ the altar of burnt offering with all its vessels, the basin and its base,¹⁰ the finely worked garments—the holy garments for Aaron the priest, the garments of his sons to minister in the priest’s office—¹¹ the anointing oil, and the incense of sweet spices for the holy place: according to all that I have commanded you they shall do.”¹² The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,¹³ “Speak also to the children of Israel, saying, ‘Most certainly you shall keep my Sabbaths; for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations, that you may know that I am the LORD who sanctifies you.¹⁴ You shall keep the Sabbath therefore, for it is holy to you. Everyone who profanes it shall surely be put to death; for whoever does any work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people.¹⁵ Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest, holy to the LORD. Who-

^{xxxiii} A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xxxiv} a gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains

^{xxxv} A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xxxvi} A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 500 shekels is about 5 kilograms or about 11 pounds.

^{xxxvii} A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

ever does any work on the Sabbath day shall surely be put to death. ¹⁶Therefore the children of Israel shall keep the Sabbath, to observe the Sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant. ¹⁷It is a sign between me and the children of Israel forever; for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he rested, and was refreshed.” ¹⁸When he finished speaking with him on Mount Sinai, he gave Moses the two tablets of the covenant, stone tablets, written with God’s finger.

32When the people saw that Moses delayed coming down from the mountain, the people gathered themselves together to Aaron, and said to him, “Come, make us gods, which shall go before us; for as for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we don’t know what has become of him.” ²Aaron said to them, “Take off the golden rings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them to me.” ³All the people took off the golden rings which were in their ears, and brought them to Aaron. ⁴He received what they handed him, fashioned it with an engraving tool, and made it a molded calf. Then they said, “These are your gods, Israel, which brought you up out of the land of Egypt.” ⁵When Aaron saw this, he built an altar before it; and Aaron made a proclamation, and said, “Tomorrow shall be a feast to the LORD.” ⁶They rose up early on the next day, and offered burnt offerings, and brought peace offerings; and the people sat down to eat and to drink, and rose up to play. ⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, “Go, get down; for your people, whom you brought up out of the land of Egypt, have corrupted themselves! ⁸They have turned away quickly out of the way which I commanded them. They have made themselves a molded calf, and have worshiped it, and have sacrificed to it, and said, ‘These are your gods, Israel, which brought you up out of the land of Egypt.’” ⁹The LORD said to Moses, “I have seen these people, and behold, they are a stiff-necked people. ¹⁰Now therefore leave me alone, that my wrath may burn hot against them, and that I may consume them; and I will make of you a great nation.” ¹¹Moses begged the LORD his God, and said, “LORD, why does your wrath burn hot against your people, that you have brought out of the land of Egypt with great power and with a mighty hand? ¹²Why should the Egyptians talk, saying, ‘He brought them out for evil, to kill them in the mountains, and to consume them from the surface of the earth?’ Turn from your fierce wrath, and turn away from this evil against your people. ¹³Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, your servants, to whom you swore by your own self, and said to them, ‘I will multiply your offspring ^{xxxviii} as the stars of the sky, and all this land that I have spoken of I will give to your offspring, and they shall inherit it forever.’” ¹⁴So The LORD turned away from the evil which he said he

would do to his people. ¹⁵Moses turned, and went down from the mountain, with the two tablets of the covenant in his hand; tablets that were written on both their sides. They were written on one side and on the other. ¹⁶The tablets were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, engraved on the tablets. ¹⁷When Joshua heard the noise of the people as they shouted, he said to Moses, “There is the noise of war in the camp.” ¹⁸He said, “It isn’t the voice of those who shout for victory. It is not the voice of those who cry for being overcome; but the noise of those who sing that I hear.” ¹⁹As soon as he came near to the camp, he saw the calf and the dancing. Then Moses’ anger grew hot, and he threw the tablets out of his hands, and broke them beneath the mountain. ²⁰He took the calf which they had made, and burned it with fire, ground it to powder, and scattered it on the water, and made the children of Israel drink it. ²¹Moses said to Aaron, “What did these people do to you, that you have brought a great sin on them?” ²²Aaron said, “Don’t let the anger of my lord grow hot. You know the people, that they are set on evil. ²³For they said to me, ‘Make us gods, which shall go before us. As for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we don’t know what has become of him.’ ²⁴I said to them, ‘Whoever has any gold, let them take it off.’ So they gave it to me; and I threw it into the fire, and out came this calf.” ²⁵When Moses saw that the people were out of control, (for Aaron had let them lose control, causing derision among their enemies), ²⁶then Moses stood in the gate of the camp, and said, “Whoever is on the LORD’s side, come to me!” All the sons of Levi gathered themselves together to him. ²⁷He said to them, “The LORD, the God of Israel, says, ‘Every man put his sword on his thigh, and go back and forth from gate to gate throughout the camp, and every man kill his brother, and every man his companion, and every man his neighbor.’” ²⁸The sons of Levi did according to the word of Moses. About three thousand men fell of the people that day. ²⁹Moses said, “Consecrate yourselves today to the LORD, for every man was against his son and against his brother, that he may give you a blessing today.” ³⁰On the next day, Moses said to the people, “You have sinned a great sin. Now I will go up to the LORD. Perhaps I shall make atonement for your sin.” ³¹Moses returned to the LORD, and said, “Oh, this people have sinned a great sin, and have made themselves gods of gold. ³²Yet now, if you will, forgive their sin—and if not, please blot me out of your book which you have written.” ³³The LORD said to Moses, “Whoever has sinned against me, I will blot him out of my book. ³⁴Now go, lead the people to the place of which I have spoken to you. Behold, my angel shall go before you. Nevertheless, in the day when I punish, I will punish them for their sin.” ³⁵The LORD struck the people, because of what they did with the calf, which Aaron made.

^{xxxviii}or, seed

33The LORD spoke to Moses, "Depart, go up from here, you and the people that you have brought up out of the land of Egypt, to the land of which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, saying, 'I will give it to your offspring.' ²I will send an angel before you; and I will drive out the Canaanite, the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite. ³Go to a land flowing with milk and honey; but I will not go up among you, for you are a stiff-necked people, lest I consume you on the way." ⁴When the people heard this evil news, they mourned; and no one put on his jewelry. ⁵The LORD had said to Moses, "Tell the children of Israel, 'You are a stiff-necked people. If I were to go up among you for one moment, I would consume you. Therefore now take off your jewelry from you, that I may know what to do to you.'" ⁶The children of Israel stripped themselves of their jewelry from Mount Horeb onward. ⁷Now Moses used to take the tent and pitch it outside the camp, far away from the camp, and he called it "The Tent of Meeting." Everyone who sought the LORD went out to the Tent of Meeting, which was outside the camp. ⁸When Moses went out to the Tent, all the people rose up, and stood, everyone at their tent door, and watched Moses, until he had gone into the Tent. ⁹When Moses entered into the Tent, the pillar of cloud descended, stood at the door of the Tent, and the LORD spoke with Moses. ¹⁰All the people saw the pillar of cloud stand at the door of the Tent, and all the people rose up and worshiped, everyone at their tent door. ¹¹The LORD spoke to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. He turned again into the camp, but his servant Joshua, the son of Nun, a young man, didn't depart from the Tent. ¹²Moses said to the LORD, "Behold, you tell me, 'Bring up this people;' and you haven't let me know whom you will send with me. Yet you have said, 'I know you by name, and you have also found favor in my sight.'" ¹³Now therefore, if I have found favor in your sight, please show me your way, now, that I may know you, so that I may find favor in your sight; and consider that this nation is your people." ¹⁴He said, "My presence will go with you, and I will give you rest." ¹⁵Moses said to him, "If your presence doesn't go with me, don't carry us up from here. ¹⁶For how would people know that I have found favor in your sight, I and your people? Isn't it that you go with us, so that we are separated, I and your people, from all the people who are on the surface of the earth?" ¹⁷The LORD said to Moses, "I will do this thing also that you have spoken; for you have found favor in my sight, and I know you by name." ¹⁸Moses said, "Please show me your glory." ¹⁹He said, "I will make all my goodness pass before you, and will proclaim the LORD's name before you. I will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will show mercy on whom I will show mercy." ²⁰He said, "You cannot see my face, for man may not see me and live." ²¹The LORD also said, "Behold, there is a place by me, and you

shall stand on the rock. ²²It will happen, while my glory passes by, that I will put you in a cleft of the rock, and will cover you with my hand until I have passed by; ²³then I will take away my hand, and you will see my back; but my face shall not be seen."

34The LORD said to Moses, "Chisel two stone tablets like the first. I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke. ²Be ready by the morning, and come up in the morning to Mount Sinai, and present yourself there to me on the top of the mountain. ³No one shall come up with you or be seen anywhere on the mountain. Do not let the flocks or herds graze in front of that mountain." ⁴He chiseled two tablets of stone like the first; then Moses rose up early in the morning, and went up to Mount Sinai, as the LORD had commanded him, and took in his hand two stone tablets. ⁵The LORD descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed the LORD's name. ⁶The LORD passed by before him, and proclaimed, "The LORD! The LORD, a merciful and gracious God, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth, ⁷keeping loving kindness for thousands, forgiving iniquity and disobedience and sin; and who will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, and on the children's children, on the third and on the fourth generation." ⁸Moses hurried and bowed his head toward the earth, and worshiped. ⁹He said, "If now I have found favor in your sight, Lord, please let the Lord go among us, even though this is a stiff-necked people; pardon our iniquity and our sin, and take us for your inheritance." ¹⁰He said, "Behold, I make a covenant: before all your people I will do marvels, such as have not been worked in all the earth, nor in any nation; and all the people among whom you are shall see the work of the LORD; for it is an awesome thing that I do with you. ¹¹Observe that which I command you today. Behold, I will drive out before you the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite. ¹²Be careful, lest you make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land where you are going, lest it be for a snare among you; ¹³but you shall break down their altars, and dash in pieces their pillars, and you shall cut down their Asherah poles; ¹⁴for you shall worship no other god; for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God. ¹⁵"Don't make a covenant with the inhabitants of the land, lest they play the prostitute after their gods, and sacrifice to their gods, and one call you and you eat of his sacrifice; ¹⁶and you take of their daughters to your sons, and their daughters play the prostitute after their gods, and make your sons play the prostitute after their gods. ¹⁷"You shall make no cast idols for yourselves. ¹⁸"You shall keep the feast of unleavened bread. Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, as I commanded you, at the time appointed in the month Abib; for in the month Abib you came out of Egypt.

¹⁹“All that opens the womb is mine; and all your livestock that is male, the firstborn of cow and sheep. ²⁰You shall redeem the firstborn of a donkey with a lamb. If you will not redeem it, then you shall break its neck. You shall redeem all the firstborn of your sons. No one shall appear before me empty. ²¹“Six days you shall work, but on the seventh day you shall rest: in plowing time and in harvest you shall rest. ²²“You shall observe the feast of weeks with the first fruits of wheat harvest, and the feast of harvest at the year’s end. ²³Three times in the year all your males shall appear before the Lord GOD, the God of Israel. ²⁴For I will drive out nations before you and enlarge your borders; neither shall any man desire your land when you go up to appear before the LORD, your God, three times in the year. ²⁵“You shall not offer the blood of my sacrifice with leavened bread. The sacrifice of the feast of the Passover shall not be left to the morning. ²⁶“You shall bring the first of the first fruits of your ground to the house of the LORD your God. “You shall not boil a young goat in its mother’s milk.” ²⁷The LORD said to Moses, “Write these words; for in accordance with these words I have made a covenant with you and with Israel.” ²⁸He was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights; he neither ate bread, nor drank water. He wrote on the tablets the words of the covenant, the ten commandments. ²⁹When Moses came down from Mount Sinai with the two tablets of the covenant in Moses’ hand, when he came down from the mountain, Moses didn’t know that the skin of his face shone by reason of his speaking with him. ³⁰When Aaron and all the children of Israel saw Moses, behold, the skin of his face shone; and they were afraid to come near him. ³¹Moses called to them, and Aaron and all the rulers of the congregation returned to him; and Moses spoke to them. ³²Afterward all the children of Israel came near, and he gave them all the commandments that the LORD had spoken with him on Mount Sinai. ³³When Moses was done speaking with them, he put a veil on his face. ³⁴But when Moses went in before the LORD to speak with him, he took the veil off, until he came out; and he came out, and spoke to the children of Israel that which he was commanded. ³⁵The children of Israel saw Moses’ face, that the skin of Moses’ face shone; so Moses put the veil on his face again, until he went in to speak with him.

35Moses assembled all the congregation of the children of Israel, and said to them, “These are the words which the LORD has commanded, that you should do them. ²“Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be a holy day for you, a Sabbath of solemn rest to the LORD: whoever does any work in it shall be put to death. ³You shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations on the Sabbath day.” ⁴Moses spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, “This is the thing which the LORD commanded, saying, ⁵“Take from among you

an offering to the LORD. Whoever is of a willing heart, let him bring it as the LORD’s offering: gold, silver, bronze, ⁶blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats’ hair, ⁷rams’ skins dyed red, sea cow hides, acacia wood, ⁸oil for the light, spices for the anointing oil and for the sweet incense, ⁹onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate. ¹⁰“Let every wise-hearted man among you come, and make all that the LORD has commanded: ¹¹the tabernacle, its outer covering, its roof, its clasps, its boards, its bars, its pillars, and its sockets; ¹²the ark, and its poles, the mercy seat, the veil of the screen; ¹³the table with its poles and all its vessels, and the show bread; ¹⁴the lamp stand also for the light, with its vessels, its lamps, and the oil for the light; ¹⁵and the altar of incense with its poles, the anointing oil, the sweet incense, the screen for the door, at the door of the tabernacle; ¹⁶the altar of burnt offering, with its grating of bronze, its poles, and all its vessels, the basin and its base; ¹⁷the hangings of the court, its pillars, their sockets, and the screen for the gate of the court; ¹⁸the pins of the tabernacle, the pins of the court, and their cords; ¹⁹the finely worked garments for ministering in the holy place—the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons—to minister in the priest’s office.” ²⁰All the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses. ²¹They came, everyone whose heart stirred him up, and everyone whom his spirit made willing, and brought the LORD’s offering for the work of the Tent of Meeting, and for all of its service, and for the holy garments. ²²They came, both men and women, as many as were willing-hearted, and brought brooches, earrings, signet rings, and armlets, all jewels of gold; even every man who offered an offering of gold to the LORD. ²³Everyone with whom was found blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats’ hair, rams’ skins dyed red, and sea cow hides, brought them. ²⁴Everyone who offered an offering of silver and bronze brought the LORD’s offering; and everyone with whom was found acacia wood for any work of the service, brought it. ²⁵All the women who were wise-hearted spun with their hands, and brought that which they had spun: the blue, the purple, the scarlet, and the fine linen. ²⁶All the women whose heart stirred them up in wisdom spun the goats’ hair. ²⁷The rulers brought the onyx stones and the stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate; ²⁸with the spice and the oil for the light, for the anointing oil, and for the sweet incense. ²⁹The children of Israel brought a free will offering to the LORD; every man and woman whose heart made them willing to bring for all the work, which the LORD had commanded to be made by Moses. ³⁰Moses said to the children of Israel, “Behold, the LORD has called by name Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah. ³¹He has filled him with the Spirit of God, in wisdom, in understanding, in knowledge, and in all kinds of workmanship; ³²and to make skillful works, to work in

gold, in silver, in bronze, ³³in cutting of stones for setting, and in carving of wood, to work in all kinds of skillful workmanship. ³⁴He has put in his heart that he may teach, both he and Oholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan. ³⁵He has filled them with wisdom of heart to work all kinds of workmanship, of the engraver, of the skillful workman, and of the embroiderer, in blue, in purple, in scarlet, and in fine linen, and of the weaver, even of those who do any workmanship, and of those who make skillful works.

36“Bezalel and Oholiab shall work with every wise-hearted man, in whom the LORD has put wisdom and understanding to know how to do all the work for the service of the sanctuary, according to all that the LORD has commanded.” ²Moses called Bezalel and Oholiab, and every wise-hearted man, in whose heart the LORD had put wisdom, even everyone whose heart stirred him up to come to the work to do it. ³They received from Moses all the offering which the children of Israel had brought for the work of the service of the sanctuary, with which to make it. They kept bringing free will offerings to him every morning. ⁴All the wise men, who performed all the work of the sanctuary, each came from his work which he did. ⁵They spoke to Moses, saying, “The people have brought much more than enough for the service of the work which the LORD commanded to make.” ⁶Moses gave a commandment, and they caused it to be proclaimed throughout the camp, saying, “Let neither man nor woman make anything else for the offering for the sanctuary.” So the people were restrained from bringing. ⁷For the stuff they had was sufficient to do all the work, and too much. ⁸All the wise-hearted men among those who did the work made the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen, blue, purple, and scarlet. They made them with cherubim, the work of a skillful workman. ⁹The length of each curtain was twenty-eight cubits, ^{xxxix} and the width of each curtain four cubits. All the curtains had one measure. ¹⁰He coupled five curtains to one another, and the other five curtains he coupled to one another. ¹¹He made loops of blue on the edge of the one curtain from the edge in the coupling. Likewise he made in the edge of the curtain that was outermost in the second coupling. ¹²He made fifty loops in the one curtain, and he made fifty loops in the edge of the curtain that was in the second coupling. The loops were opposite to one another. ¹³He made fifty clasps of gold, and coupled the curtains to one another with the clasps: so the tabernacle was a unit. ¹⁴He made curtains of goats’ hair for a covering over the tabernacle. He made them eleven curtains. ¹⁵The length of each curtain was thirty cubits, and four cubits the width of each curtain. The eleven curtains had one measure. ¹⁶He coupled five curtains by themselves, and

six curtains by themselves. ¹⁷He made fifty loops on the edge of the curtain that was outermost in the coupling, and he made fifty loops on the edge of the curtain which was outermost in the second coupling. ¹⁸He made fifty clasps of bronze to couple the tent together, that it might be a unit. ¹⁹He made a covering for the tent of rams’ skins dyed red, and a covering of sea cow hides above. ²⁰He made the boards for the tabernacle of acacia wood, standing up. ²¹Ten cubits was the length of a board, and a cubit and a half the width of each board. ²²Each board had two tenons, joined to one another. He made all the boards of the tabernacle this way. ²³He made the boards for the tabernacle, twenty boards for the south side southward. ²⁴He made forty sockets of silver under the twenty boards: two sockets under one board for its two tenons, and two sockets under another board for its two tenons. ²⁵For the second side of the tabernacle, on the north side, he made twenty boards ²⁶and their forty sockets of silver: two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board. ²⁷For the far part of the tabernacle westward he made six boards. ²⁸He made two boards for the corners of the tabernacle in the far part. ²⁹They were double beneath, and in the same way they were all the way to its top to one ring. He did this to both of them in the two corners. ³⁰There were eight boards and their sockets of silver, sixteen sockets—under every board two sockets. ³¹He made bars of acacia wood: five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle, ³²and five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the tabernacle for the hinder part westward. ³³He made the middle bar to pass through in the middle of the boards from the one end to the other. ³⁴He overlaid the boards with gold, and made their rings of gold as places for the bars, and overlaid the bars with gold. ³⁵He made the veil of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen, with cherubim. He made it the work of a skillful workman. ³⁶He made four pillars of acacia for it, and overlaid them with gold. Their hooks were of gold. He cast four sockets of silver for them. ³⁷He made a screen for the door of the tent, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen, the work of an embroiderer; ³⁸and the five pillars of it with their hooks. He overlaid their capitals and their fillets with gold, and their five sockets were of bronze.

37Bezalel made the ark of acacia wood. Its length was two and a half cubits, ^{x1} and its width a cubit and a half, and a cubit and a half its height. ²He overlaid it with pure gold inside and outside, and made a molding of gold for it around it. ³He cast four rings of gold for it in its four feet—two rings on its one side, and two rings on its other side. ⁴He made poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with gold. ⁵He put the poles into the rings on the

^{xxxix}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{x1}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

sides of the ark, to bear the ark. ⁶He made a mercy seat of pure gold. Its length was two and a half cubits, and a cubit and a half its width. ⁷He made two cherubim of gold. He made them of beaten work, at the two ends of the mercy seat: ⁸one cherub at the one end, and one cherub at the other end. He made the cherubim of one piece with the mercy seat at its two ends. ⁹The cherubim spread out their wings above, covering the mercy seat with their wings, with their faces toward one another. The faces of the cherubim were toward the mercy seat. ¹⁰He made the table of acacia wood. Its length was two cubits, and its width was a cubit, and its height was a cubit and a half. ¹¹He overlaid it with pure gold, and made a gold molding around it. ¹²He made a border of a hand's width around it, and made a golden molding on its border around it. ¹³He cast four rings of gold for it, and put the rings in the four corners that were on its four feet. ¹⁴The rings were close by the border, the places for the poles to carry the table. ¹⁵He made the poles of acacia wood, and overlaid them with gold, to carry the table. ¹⁶He made the vessels which were on the table, its dishes, its spoons, its bowls, and its pitchers with which to pour out, of pure gold. ¹⁷He made the lamp stand of pure gold. He made the lamp stand of beaten work. Its base, its shaft, its cups, its buds, and its flowers were of one piece with it. ¹⁸There were six branches going out of its sides: three branches of the lamp stand out of its one side, and three branches of the lamp stand out of its other side: ¹⁹three cups made like almond blossoms in one branch, a bud and a flower, and three cups made like almond blossoms in the other branch, a bud and a flower; so for the six branches going out of the lamp stand. ²⁰In the lamp stand were four cups made like almond blossoms, its buds and its flowers; ²¹and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, and a bud under two branches of one piece with it, for the six branches going out of it. ²²Their buds and their branches were of one piece with it. The whole thing was one beaten work of pure gold. ²³He made its seven lamps, and its snuffers, and its snuff dishes, of pure gold. ²⁴He made it of a talent ^{xli} of pure gold, with all its vessels. ²⁵He made the altar of incense of acacia wood. It was square: its length was a cubit, and its width a cubit. Its height was two cubits. Its horns were of one piece with it. ²⁶He overlaid it with pure gold: its top, its sides around it, and its horns. He made a gold molding around it. ²⁷He made two golden rings for it under its molding crown, on its two ribs, on its two sides, for places for poles with which to carry it. ²⁸He made the poles of acacia wood, and overlaid them with gold. ²⁹He made the holy anointing oil and the pure incense of sweet spices, after the art of the perfumer.

38He made the altar of burnt offering of acacia wood.

^{xli}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

It was square. Its length was five cubits, ^{xlii} its width was five cubits, and its height was three cubits. ²He made its horns on its four corners. Its horns were of one piece with it, and he overlaid it with bronze. ³He made all the vessels of the altar: the pots, the shovels, the basins, the forks, and the fire pans. He made all its vessels of bronze. ⁴He made for the altar a grating of a network of bronze, under the ledge around it beneath, reaching halfway up. ⁵He cast four rings for the four corners of bronze grating, to be places for the poles. ⁶He made the poles of acacia wood, and overlaid them with bronze. ⁷He put the poles into the rings on the sides of the altar, with which to carry it. He made it hollow with planks. ⁸He made the basin of bronze, and its base of bronze, out of the mirrors of the ministering women who ministered at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁹He made the court: for the south side southward the hangings of the court were of fine twined linen, one hundred cubits; ¹⁰their pillars were twenty, and their sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver. ¹¹For the north side one hundred cubits, their pillars twenty, and their sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks of the pillars, and their fillets, of silver. ¹²For the west side were hangings of fifty cubits, their pillars ten, and their sockets ten; the hooks of the pillars, and their fillets, of silver. ¹³For the east side eastward fifty cubits, ¹⁴the hangings for the one side were fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three; ¹⁵and so for the other side: on this hand and that hand by the gate of the court were hangings of fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their sockets three. ¹⁶All the hangings around the court were of fine twined linen. ¹⁷The sockets for the pillars were of bronze. The hooks of the pillars and their fillets were of silver. Their capitals were overlaid with silver. All the pillars of the court had silver bands. ¹⁸The screen for the gate of the court was the work of the embroiderer, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen. Twenty cubits was the length, and the height along the width was five cubits, like the hangings of the court. ¹⁹Their pillars were four, and their sockets four, of bronze; their hooks of silver, and the overlaying of their capitals, and their fillets, of silver. ²⁰All the pins of the tabernacle, and around the court, were of bronze. ²¹These are the amounts of materials used for the tabernacle, even the Tabernacle of the Testimony, as they were counted, according to the commandment of Moses, for the service of the Levites, by the hand of Ithamar, the son of Aaron the priest. ²²Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made all that the LORD commanded Moses. ²³With him was Oholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an engraver, and a skillful workman, and an embroiderer in blue, in purple, in scarlet, and in fine linen. ²⁴All the gold that was used for the work in all the work of the sanctuary, even the gold of the

^{xlii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

offering, was twenty-nine talents ^{xliii} and seven hundred thirty shekels, according to the shekel ^{xliv} of the sanctuary. ²⁵The silver of those who were counted of the congregation was one hundred talents ^{xlvi} and one thousand seven hundred seventy-five shekels, ^{xlvii} according to the shekel of the sanctuary: ²⁶a beka ^{xlviii} a head, that is, half a shekel, according to the shekel ^{xlviii} of the sanctuary, for everyone who passed over to those who were counted, from twenty years old and upward, for six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty men. ²⁷The one hundred talents ^{xlix} of silver were for casting the sockets of the sanctuary and the sockets of the veil: one hundred sockets for the one hundred talents, one talent per socket. ²⁸From the one thousand seven hundred seventy-five shekels ⁱ he made hooks for the pillars, overlaid their capitals, and made fillets for them. ²⁹The bronze of the offering was seventy talents ^{li} and two thousand four hundred shekels. ^{lii} ³⁰With this he made the sockets to the door of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar, the bronze grating for it, all the vessels of the altar, ³¹the sockets around the court, the sockets of the gate of the court, all the pins of the tabernacle, and all the pins around the court.

39Of the blue, purple, and scarlet, they made finely worked garments for ministering in the holy place, and made the holy garments for Aaron, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²He made the ephod of gold, blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen. ³They beat the gold into thin plates, and cut it into wires, to work it in with the blue, the purple, the scarlet, and the fine linen, the work of the skillful workman. ⁴They made shoulder straps for it, joined together. It was joined together at the two ends. ⁵The skillfully woven band that was on it, with which to fasten it on, was of the same piece, like its work: of gold, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen, as the LORD commanded Moses. ⁶They worked the onyx stones, enclosed in settings of gold, engraved with the engravings of a signet, according to the names of the children of Israel. ⁷He put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod, to be stones of memorial for the children of Israel, as the LORD commanded Moses. ⁸He made the breastplate, the work of a skillful workman, like the work of the ephod: of gold, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen. ⁹It was square. They made the breastplate double. Its length was a span,

^{liii} and its width a span, being double. ¹⁰They set in it four rows of stones. A row of ruby, topaz, and beryl was the first row; ¹¹and the second row, a turquoise, a sapphire, ^{liv} and an emerald; ¹²and the third row, a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst; ¹³and the fourth row, a chrysolite, an onyx, and a jasper. They were enclosed in gold settings. ¹⁴The stones were according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names; like the engravings of a signet, everyone according to his name, for the twelve tribes. ¹⁵They made on the breastplate chains like cords, of braided work of pure gold. ¹⁶They made two settings of gold, and two gold rings, and put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate. ¹⁷They put the two braided chains of gold in the two rings at the ends of the breastplate. ¹⁸The other two ends of the two braided chains they put on the two settings, and put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod, in its front. ¹⁹They made two rings of gold, and put them on the two ends of the breastplate, on its edge, which was toward the side of the ephod inward. ²⁰They made two more rings of gold, and put them on the two shoulder straps of the ephod underneath, in its front, close by its coupling, above the skillfully woven band of the ephod. ²¹They bound the breastplate by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it might be on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, and that the breastplate might not come loose from the ephod, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²²He made the robe of the ephod of woven work, all of blue. ²³The opening of the robe in the middle of it was like the opening of a coat of mail, with a binding around its opening, that it should not be torn. ²⁴They made on the skirts of the robe pomegranates of blue, purple, scarlet, and twined linen. ²⁵They made bells of pure gold, and put the bells between the pomegranates around the skirts of the robe, between the pomegranates; ²⁶a bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate, around the skirts of the robe, to minister in, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²⁷They made the tunics of fine linen of woven work for Aaron and for his sons, ²⁸the turban of fine linen, the linen headbands of fine linen, the linen trousers of fine twined linen, ²⁹the sash of fine twined linen, blue, purple, and scarlet, the work of the embroiderer, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³⁰They made the plate of the holy crown of pure gold, and wrote on it an inscription, like the engravings of a signet: "HOLY TO THE LORD". ³¹They tied to it a lace of blue, to fasten it on the turban above, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³²Thus all the work of the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting was finished. The children of Israel did according to all that the LORD commanded Moses; so they did. ³³They brought the tabernacle to Moses: the

^{xliii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces.

^{xliv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces.

^{xlv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{xlvi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xlvii}a beka is about 5 grams or about 0.175 ounces

^{xlviii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xlix}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

ⁱA shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1775 shekels is about 17.75 kilograms or about 39 pounds.

^{li}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{lii}70 talents + 2400 shekels is about 2124 kilograms, or 2.124 metric tons.

^{liii}A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.)

^{liv}or, lapis lazuli

tent, with all its furniture, its clasps, its boards, its bars, its pillars, its sockets, ³⁴the covering of rams' skins dyed red, the covering of sea cow hides, the veil of the screen, ³⁵the ark of the covenant with its poles, the mercy seat, ³⁶the table, all its vessels, the show bread, ³⁷the pure lamp stand, its lamps, even the lamps to be set in order, all its vessels, the oil for the light, ³⁸the golden altar, the anointing oil, the sweet incense, the screen for the door of the Tent, ³⁹the bronze altar, its grating of bronze, its poles, all of its vessels, the basin and its base, ⁴⁰the hangings of the court, its pillars, its sockets, the screen for the gate of the court, its cords, its pins, and all the instruments of the service of the tabernacle, for the Tent of Meeting, ⁴¹the finely worked garments for ministering in the holy place, the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons, to minister in the priest's office. ⁴²According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel did all the work. ⁴³Moses saw all the work, and behold, they had done it as the LORD had commanded. They had done so; and Moses blessed them.

⁴⁰The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"On the first day of the first month you shall raise up the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting. ³You shall put the ark of the covenant in it, and you shall screen the ark with the veil. ⁴You shall bring in the table, and set in order the things that are on it. You shall bring in the lamp stand, and light its lamps. ⁵You shall set the golden altar for incense before the ark of the covenant, and put the screen of the door to the tabernacle. ⁶"You shall set the altar of burnt offering before the door of the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting. ⁷You shall set the basin between the Tent of Meeting and the altar, and shall put water therein. ⁸You shall set up the court around it, and hang up the screen of the gate of the court. ⁹"You shall take the anointing oil, and anoint the tabernacle and all that is in it, and shall make it holy, and all its furniture, and it will be holy. ¹⁰You shall anoint the altar of burnt offering, with all its vessels, and sanctify the altar, and the altar will be most holy. ¹¹You shall anoint the basin and its base, and sanctify it. ¹²"You shall bring Aaron and his sons to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and shall wash them with water. ¹³You shall put on Aaron the holy garments; and you shall anoint him, and sanctify him, that he may minister to me in the priest's office. ¹⁴You shall bring his sons, and put tunics on them. ¹⁵You shall anoint them, as you anointed their father, that they may minister to me in the priest's office. Their anointing shall be to them for an everlasting priesthood throughout their generations." ¹⁶Moses did so. According to all that the LORD commanded him, so he did. ¹⁷In the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, the tabernacle was raised up. ¹⁸Moses raised up the tabernacle, and laid its sockets, and set up its boards, and put in its bars, and raised up its pillars.

¹⁹He spread the covering over the tent, and put the roof of the tabernacle above on it, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²⁰He took and put the covenant into the ark, and set the poles on the ark, and put the mercy seat above on the ark. ²¹He brought the ark into the tabernacle, and set up the veil of the screen, and screened the ark of the covenant, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²²He put the table in the Tent of Meeting, on the north side of the tabernacle, outside of the veil. ²³He set the bread in order on it before the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²⁴He put the lamp stand in the Tent of Meeting, opposite the table, on the south side of the tabernacle. ²⁵He lit the lamps before the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²⁶He put the golden altar in the Tent of Meeting before the veil; ²⁷and he burned incense of sweet spices on it, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²⁸He put up the screen of the door to the tabernacle. ²⁹He set the altar of burnt offering at the door of the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting, and offered on it the burnt offering and the meal offering, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³⁰He set the basin between the Tent of Meeting and the altar, and put water therein, with which to wash. ³¹Moses, Aaron, and his sons washed their hands and their feet there. ³²When they went into the Tent of Meeting, and when they came near to the altar, they washed, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³³He raised up the court around the tabernacle and the altar, and set up the screen of the gate of the court. So Moses finished the work. ³⁴Then the cloud covered the Tent of Meeting, and the LORD's glory filled the tabernacle. ³⁵Moses wasn't able to enter into the Tent of Meeting, because the cloud stayed on it, and the LORD's glory filled the tabernacle. ³⁶When the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel went onward, throughout all their journeys; ³⁷but if the cloud wasn't taken up, then they didn't travel until the day that it was taken up. ³⁸For the cloud of the LORD was on the tabernacle by day, and there was fire in the cloud by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel, throughout all their journeys.

Leviticus

¹The LORD ⁱ called to Moses, and spoke to him from the Tent of Meeting, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘When anyone of you offers an offering to the LORD, you shall offer your offering of the livestock, from the herd and from the flock. ³“‘If his offering is a burnt offering from the herd, he shall offer a male without defect. He shall offer it at the door of the Tent of Meeting, that he may be accepted before the LORD. ⁴He shall lay his hand on the head of the burnt offering, and it shall be accepted for him to make atonement for him. ⁵He shall kill the bull before the LORD. Aaron’s sons, the priests, shall present the blood and sprinkle the blood around on the altar that is at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁶He shall skin the burnt offering and cut it into pieces. ⁷The sons of Aaron the priest shall put fire on the altar, and lay wood in order on the fire; ⁸and Aaron’s sons, the priests, shall lay the pieces, the head, and the fat in order on the wood that is on the fire which is on the altar; ⁹but he shall wash its innards and its legs with water. The priest shall burn all of it on the altar, for a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹⁰“‘If his offering is from the flock, from the sheep or from the goats, for a burnt offering, he shall offer a male without defect. ¹¹He shall kill it on the north side of the altar before the LORD. Aaron’s sons, the priests, shall sprinkle its blood around on the altar. ¹²He shall cut it into its pieces, with its head and its fat. The priest shall lay them in order on the wood that is on the fire which is on the altar, ¹³but the innards and the legs he shall wash with water. The priest shall offer the whole, and burn it on the altar. It is a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹⁴“‘If his offering to the LORD is a burnt offering of birds, then he shall offer his offering from turtledoves or of young pigeons. ¹⁵The priest shall bring it to the altar, and wring off its head, and burn it on the altar; and its blood shall be drained out on the side of the altar; ¹⁶and he shall take away its crop and its feathers, and cast it beside the altar on the east part, in the place of the ashes. ¹⁷He shall tear it by its wings, but shall not divide it apart. The priest shall burn it on the altar, on the

wood that is on the fire. It is a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD.

²“‘When anyone offers an offering of a meal offering to the LORD, his offering shall be of fine flour. He shall pour oil on it, and put frankincense on it. ²He shall bring it to Aaron’s sons, the priests. He shall take his handful of its fine flour, and of its oil, with all its frankincense, and the priest shall burn its memorial on the altar, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ³That which is left of the meal offering shall be Aaron’s and his sons’. It is a most holy part of the offerings of the LORD made by fire. ⁴“‘When you offer an offering of a meal offering baked in the oven, it shall be unleavened cakes of fine flour mixed with oil, or unleavened wafers anointed with oil. ⁵If your offering is a meal offering made on a griddle, it shall be of unleavened fine flour, mixed with oil. ⁶You shall cut it in pieces, and pour oil on it. It is a meal offering. ⁷If your offering is a meal offering of the pan, it shall be made of fine flour with oil. ⁸You shall bring the meal offering that is made of these things to the LORD. It shall be presented to the priest, and he shall bring it to the altar. ⁹The priest shall take from the meal offering its memorial, and shall burn it on the altar, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹⁰That which is left of the meal offering shall be Aaron’s and his sons’. It is a most holy part of the offerings of the LORD made by fire. ¹¹“‘No meal offering which you shall offer to the LORD shall be made with yeast; for you shall burn no yeast, nor any honey, as an offering made by fire to the LORD. ¹²As an offering of first fruits you shall offer them to the LORD, but they shall not rise up as a pleasant aroma on the altar. ¹³Every offering of your meal offering you shall season with salt. You shall not allow the salt of the covenant of your God ⁱⁱ to be lacking from your meal offering. With all your offerings you shall offer salt. ¹⁴“‘If you offer a meal offering of first fruits to the LORD, you shall offer for the meal offering of your first fruits fresh heads of grain parched with fire and crushed. ¹⁵You shall put oil on it and lay frankincense on it. It is a meal offering. ¹⁶The priest shall burn as its memorial part of its crushed

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is “ (Elohim).

grain and part of its oil, along with all its frankincense. It is an offering made by fire to the LORD.

³“If his offering is a sacrifice of peace offerings, if he offers it from the herd, whether male or female, he shall offer it without defect before the LORD. ²He shall lay his hand on the head of his offering, and kill it at the door of the Tent of Meeting. Aaron’s sons, the priests, shall sprinkle the blood around on the altar. ³He shall offer of the sacrifice of peace offerings an offering made by fire to the LORD. The fat that covers the innards, and all the fat that is on the innards, ⁴and the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the loins, and the cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he shall take away. ⁵Aaron’s sons shall burn it on the altar on the burnt offering, which is on the wood that is on the fire: it is an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ⁶“If his offering for a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD is from the flock, either male or female, he shall offer it without defect. ⁷If he offers a lamb for his offering, then he shall offer it before the LORD; ⁸and he shall lay his hand on the head of his offering, and kill it before the Tent of Meeting. Aaron’s sons shall sprinkle its blood around on the altar. ⁹He shall offer from the sacrifice of peace offerings an offering made by fire to the LORD; its fat, the entire tail fat, he shall take away close to the backbone; and the fat that covers the entrails, and all the fat that is on the entrails, ¹⁰and the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the loins, and the cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he shall take away. ¹¹The priest shall burn it on the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire to the LORD. ¹²“If his offering is a goat, then he shall offer it before the LORD. ¹³He shall lay his hand on its head, and kill it before the Tent of Meeting; and the sons of Aaron shall sprinkle its blood around on the altar. ¹⁴He shall offer from it as his offering, an offering made by fire to the LORD; the fat that covers the innards, and all the fat that is on the innards, ¹⁵and the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the loins, and the cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he shall take away. ¹⁶The priest shall burn them on the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire, for a pleasant aroma; all the fat is the LORD’s. ¹⁷“It shall be a perpetual statute throughout your generations in all your dwellings, that you shall eat neither fat nor blood.”

⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘If anyone sins unintentionally, in any of the things which the LORD has commanded not to be done, and does any one of them, ³if the anointed priest sins so as to bring guilt on the people, then let him offer for his sin which he has sinned a young bull without defect to the LORD for a sin offering. ⁴He shall bring the bull to the door of the Tent of Meeting before the LORD; and he

shall lay his hand on the head of the bull, and kill the bull before the LORD. ⁵The anointed priest shall take some of the blood of the bull, and bring it to the Tent of Meeting. ⁶The priest shall dip his finger in the blood, and sprinkle some of the blood seven times before the LORD, before the veil of the sanctuary. ⁷The priest shall put some of the blood on the horns of the altar of sweet incense before the LORD, which is in the Tent of Meeting; and he shall pour out the rest of the blood of the bull at the base of the altar of burnt offering, which is at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁸He shall take all the fat of the bull of the sin offering from it: the fat that covers the innards, and all the fat that is on the innards, ⁹and the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the loins, and the cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he shall remove, ¹⁰as it is removed from the bull of the sacrifice of peace offerings. The priest shall burn them on the altar of burnt offering. ¹¹He shall carry the bull’s skin, all its meat, with its head, and with its legs, its innards, and its dung ¹²—all the rest of the bull—outside of the camp to a clean place where the ashes are poured out, and burn it on wood with fire. It shall be burned where the ashes are poured out. ¹³“If the whole congregation of Israel sins, and the thing is hidden from the eyes of the assembly, and they have done any of the things which the LORD has commanded not to be done, and are guilty; ¹⁴when the sin in which they have sinned is known, then the assembly shall offer a young bull for a sin offering, and bring it before the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁵The elders of the congregation shall lay their hands on the head of the bull before the LORD; and the bull shall be killed before the LORD. ¹⁶The anointed priest shall bring some of the blood of the bull to the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁷The priest shall dip his finger in the blood and sprinkle it seven times before the LORD, before the veil. ¹⁸He shall put some of the blood on the horns of the altar which is before the LORD, that is in the Tent of Meeting; and the rest of the blood he shall pour out at the base of the altar of burnt offering, which is at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁹All its fat he shall take from it, and burn it on the altar. ²⁰He shall do this with the bull; as he did with the bull of the sin offering, so he shall do with this; and the priest shall make atonement for them, and they shall be forgiven. ²¹He shall carry the bull outside the camp, and burn it as he burned the first bull. It is the sin offering for the assembly. ²²“When a ruler sins, and unwittingly does any one of all the things which the LORD his God has commanded not to be done, and is guilty, ²³if his sin in which he has sinned is made known to him, he shall bring as his offering a goat, a male without defect. ²⁴He shall lay his hand on the head of the goat, and kill it in the place where they kill the burnt offering before the LORD. It is a sin offering. ²⁵The priest shall take some of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering. He

shall pour out the rest of its blood at the base of the altar of burnt offering. ²⁶All its fat he shall burn on the altar, like the fat of the sacrifice of peace offerings; and the priest shall make atonement for him concerning his sin, and he will be forgiven. ²⁷“If anyone of the common people sins unwittingly, in doing any of the things which the LORD has commanded not to be done, and is guilty, ²⁸if his sin which he has sinned is made known to him, then he shall bring for his offering a goat, a female without defect, for his sin which he has sinned. ²⁹He shall lay his hand on the head of the sin offering, and kill the sin offering in the place of burnt offering. ³⁰The priest shall take some of its blood with his finger, and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering; and the rest of its blood he shall pour out at the base of the altar. ³¹All its fat he shall take away, like the fat is taken away from the sacrifice of peace offerings; and the priest shall burn it on the altar for a pleasant aroma to the LORD; and the priest shall make atonement for him, and he will be forgiven. ³²“If he brings a lamb as his offering for a sin offering, he shall bring a female without defect. ³³He shall lay his hand on the head of the sin offering, and kill it for a sin offering in the place where they kill the burnt offering. ³⁴The priest shall take some of the blood of the sin offering with his finger, and put it on the horns of the altar of burnt offering; and all the rest of its blood he shall pour out at the base of the altar. ³⁵He shall remove all its fat, like the fat of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice of peace offerings. The priest shall burn them on the altar, on the offerings of the LORD made by fire. The priest shall make atonement for him concerning his sin that he has sinned, and he will be forgiven.

⁵“If anyone sins, in that he hears a public adjuration to testify, he being a witness, whether he has seen or known, if he doesn’t report it, then he shall bear his iniquity. ²“Or if anyone touches any unclean thing, whether it is the carcass of an unclean animal, or the carcass of unclean livestock, or the carcass of unclean creeping things, and it is hidden from him, and he is unclean, then he shall be guilty. ³“Or if he touches the uncleanness of man, whatever his uncleanness is with which he is unclean, and it is hidden from him; when he knows of it, then he shall be guilty. ⁴“Or if anyone swears rashly with his lips to do evil or to do good—whatever it is that a man might utter rashly with an oath, and it is hidden from him—when he knows of it, then he will be guilty of one of these. ⁵It shall be, when he is guilty of one of these, he shall confess that in which he has sinned; ⁶and he shall bring his trespass offering to the LORD for his sin which he has sinned: a female from the flock, a lamb or a goat, for a sin offering; and the priest shall make atonement for him concerning his sin. ⁷“If he can’t afford a lamb, then he shall bring his trespass offering for that in which he has sinned, two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, to the LORD; one for a sin offering, and

the other for a burnt offering. ⁸He shall bring them to the priest, who shall first offer the one which is for the sin offering. He shall wring off its head from its neck, but shall not sever it completely. ⁹He shall sprinkle some of the blood of the sin offering on the side of the altar; and the rest of the blood shall be drained out at the base of the altar. It is a sin offering. ¹⁰He shall offer the second for a burnt offering, according to the ordinance; and the priest shall make atonement for him concerning his sin which he has sinned, and he shall be forgiven. ¹¹“But if he can’t afford two turtledoves or two young pigeons, then he shall bring as his offering for that in which he has sinned, one tenth of an ephah ⁱⁱⁱ of fine flour for a sin offering. He shall put no oil on it, and he shall not put any frankincense on it, for it is a sin offering. ¹²He shall bring it to the priest, and the priest shall take his handful of it as the memorial portion, and burn it on the altar, on the offerings of the LORD made by fire. It is a sin offering. ¹³The priest shall make atonement for him concerning his sin that he has sinned in any of these things, and he will be forgiven; and the rest shall be the priest’s, as the meal offering.” ¹⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁵“If anyone commits a trespass, and sins unwittingly regarding the LORD’s holy things, then he shall bring his trespass offering to the LORD: a ram without defect from the flock, according to your estimation in silver by shekels, according to the shekel ^{iv} of the sanctuary, for a trespass offering. ¹⁶He shall make restitution for that which he has done wrong regarding the holy thing, and shall add a fifth part to it, and give it to the priest; and the priest shall make atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering, and he will be forgiven. ¹⁷“If anyone sins, doing any of the things which the LORD has commanded not to be done, though he didn’t know it, he is still guilty, and shall bear his iniquity. ¹⁸He shall bring a ram without defect from of the flock, according to your estimation, for a trespass offering, to the priest; and the priest shall make atonement for him concerning the thing in which he sinned and didn’t know it, and he will be forgiven. ¹⁹It is a trespass offering. He is certainly guilty before the LORD.”

⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“If anyone sins, and commits a trespass against the LORD, and deals falsely with his neighbor in a matter of deposit, or of bargain, or of robbery, or has oppressed his neighbor, ³or has found that which was lost, and lied about it, and swearing to a lie—in any of these things that a man sins in his actions—⁴then it shall be, if he has sinned, and is guilty, he shall restore that which he took by robbery, or the thing which he has gotten by oppression, or the deposit which was committed to him, or the lost thing which he found, ⁵or any thing about which he has sworn falsely: he shall restore

ⁱⁱⁱ1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{iv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

it in full, and shall add a fifth part more to it. He shall return it to him to whom it belongs in the day of his being found guilty. ⁶He shall bring his trespass offering to the LORD: a ram without defect from the flock, according to your estimation, for a trespass offering, to the priest. ⁷The priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD, and he will be forgiven concerning whatever he does to become guilty.” ⁸The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁹“Command Aaron and his sons, saying, ‘This is the law of the burnt offering: the burnt offering shall be on the hearth on the altar all night until the morning; and the fire of the altar shall be kept burning on it. ¹⁰The priest shall put on his linen garment, and he shall put on his linen trousers upon his body; and he shall remove the ashes from where the fire has consumed the burnt offering on the altar, and he shall put them beside the altar. ¹¹He shall take off his garments, and put on other garments, and carry the ashes outside the camp to a clean place. ¹²The fire on the altar shall be kept burning on it, it shall not go out; and the priest shall burn wood on it every morning. He shall lay the burnt offering in order upon it, and shall burn on it the fat of the peace offerings. ¹³Fire shall be kept burning on the altar continually; it shall not go out. ¹⁴“This is the law of the meal offering: the sons of Aaron shall offer it before the LORD, before the altar. ¹⁵He shall take from there his handful of the fine flour of the meal offering, and of its oil, and all the frankincense which is on the meal offering, and shall burn it on the altar for a pleasant aroma, as its memorial portion, to the LORD. ¹⁶That which is left of it Aaron and his sons shall eat. It shall be eaten without yeast in a holy place. They shall eat it in the court of the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁷It shall not be baked with yeast. I have given it as their portion of my offerings made by fire. It is most holy, as are the sin offering and the trespass offering. ¹⁸Every male among the children of Aaron shall eat of it, as their portion forever throughout your generations, from the offerings of the LORD made by fire. Whoever touches them shall be holy.’” ¹⁹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁰“This is the offering of Aaron and of his sons, which they shall offer to the LORD in the day when he is anointed: one tenth of an ephah ^v of fine flour for a meal offering perpetually, half of it in the morning, and half of it in the evening. ²¹It shall be made with oil in a griddle. When it is soaked, you shall bring it in. You shall offer the meal offering in baked pieces for a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ²²The anointed priest that will be in his place from among his sons shall offer it. By a statute forever, it shall be wholly burned to the LORD. ²³Every meal offering of a priest shall be wholly burned. It shall not be eaten.” ²⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁵“Speak to Aaron and to his sons, saying, ‘This is the law of the sin offering: in the place where the burnt offering is killed, the sin offering shall be killed before the LORD. It

is most holy. ²⁶The priest who offers it for sin shall eat it. It shall be eaten in a holy place, in the court of the Tent of Meeting. ²⁷Whatever shall touch its flesh shall be holy. When there is any of its blood sprinkled on a garment, you shall wash that on which it was sprinkled in a holy place. ²⁸But the earthen vessel in which it is boiled shall be broken; and if it is boiled in a bronze vessel, it shall be scoured, and rinsed in water. ²⁹Every male among the priests shall eat of it. It is most holy. ³⁰No sin offering, of which any of the blood is brought into the Tent of Meeting to make atonement in the Holy Place, shall be eaten. It shall be burned with fire.

⁷“This is the law of the trespass offering: It is most holy. ²In the place where they kill the burnt offering, he shall kill the trespass offering; and its blood he shall sprinkle around on the altar. ³He shall offer all of its fat: the fat tail, and the fat that covers the innards, ⁴and he shall take away the two kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which is by the loins, and the cover on the liver, with the kidneys; ⁵and the priest shall burn them on the altar for an offering made by fire to the LORD: it is a trespass offering. ⁶Every male among the priests may eat of it. It shall be eaten in a holy place. It is most holy. ⁷“As is the sin offering, so is the trespass offering; there is one law for them. The priest who makes atonement with them shall have it. ⁸The priest who offers any man’s burnt offering shall have for himself the skin of the burnt offering which he has offered. ⁹Every meal offering that is baked in the oven, and all that is prepared in the pan and on the griddle, shall be the priest’s who offers it. ¹⁰Every meal offering, mixed with oil or dry, belongs to all the sons of Aaron, one as well as another. ¹¹“This is the law of the sacrifice of peace offerings, which one shall offer to the LORD: ¹²If he offers it for a thanksgiving, then he shall offer with the sacrifice of thanksgiving unleavened cakes mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed with oil, and cakes mixed with oil. ¹³He shall offer his offering with the sacrifice of his peace offerings for thanksgiving with cakes of leavened bread. ¹⁴Of it he shall offer one out of each offering for a heave offering to the LORD. It shall be the priest’s who sprinkles the blood of the peace offerings. ¹⁵The flesh of the sacrifice of his peace offerings for thanksgiving shall be eaten on the day of his offering. He shall not leave any of it until the morning. ¹⁶“But if the sacrifice of his offering is a vow, or a free will offering, it shall be eaten on the day that he offers his sacrifice. On the next day what remains of it shall be eaten, ¹⁷but what remains of the meat of the sacrifice on the third day shall be burned with fire. ¹⁸If any of the meat of the sacrifice of his peace offerings is eaten on the third day, it will not be accepted, and it shall not be credited to him who offers it. It will be an abomination, and the soul who eats any of it will bear his iniquity. ¹⁹“The meat that touches any unclean

^v1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

thing shall not be eaten. It shall be burned with fire. As for the meat, everyone who is clean may eat it; ²⁰but the soul who eats of the meat of the sacrifice of peace offerings that belongs to the LORD, having his uncleanness on him, that soul shall be cut off from his people. ²¹When anyone touches any unclean thing, the uncleanness of man, or an unclean animal, or any unclean abomination, and eats some of the meat of the sacrifice of peace offerings which belong to the LORD, that soul shall be cut off from his people.” ²²The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²³“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘You shall eat no fat, of bull, or sheep, or goat. ²⁴The fat of that which dies of itself, and the fat of that which is torn of animals, may be used for any other service, but you shall in no way eat of it. ²⁵For whoever eats the fat of the animal which men offer as an offering made by fire to the LORD, even the soul who eats it shall be cut off from his people. ²⁶You shall not eat any blood, whether it is of bird or of animal, in any of your dwellings. ²⁷Whoever it is who eats any blood, that soul shall be cut off from his people.’” ²⁸The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁹“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘He who offers the sacrifice of his peace offerings to the LORD shall bring his offering to the LORD out of the sacrifice of his peace offerings. ³⁰With his own hands he shall bring the offerings of the LORD made by fire. He shall bring the fat with the breast, that the breast may be waved for a wave offering before the LORD. ³¹The priest shall burn the fat on the altar, but the breast shall be Aaron’s and his sons’. ³²The right thigh you shall give to the priest for a heave offering out of the sacrifices of your peace offerings. ³³He among the sons of Aaron who offers the blood of the peace offerings, and the fat, shall have the right thigh for a portion. ³⁴For the waved breast and the heaved thigh I have taken from the children of Israel out of the sacrifices of their peace offerings, and have given them to Aaron the priest and to his sons as their portion forever from the children of Israel.’” ³⁵This is the consecrated portion of Aaron, and the consecrated portion of his sons, out of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, in the day when he presented them to minister to the LORD in the priest’s office; ³⁶which the LORD commanded to be given them of the children of Israel, in the day that he anointed them. It is their portion forever throughout their generations. ³⁷This is the law of the burnt offering, the meal offering, the sin offering, the trespass offering, the consecration, and the sacrifice of peace offerings ³⁸which the LORD commanded Moses in Mount Sinai in the day that he commanded the children of Israel to offer their offerings to the LORD, in the wilderness of Sinai.

⁸The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Take Aaron and his sons with him, and the garments, and the anointing oil, and the bull of the sin offering, and the two rams, and the basket of unleavened bread; ³and assemble all the con-

gregation at the door of the Tent of Meeting.” ⁴Moses did as the LORD commanded him; and the congregation was assembled at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁵Moses said to the congregation, “This is the thing which the LORD has commanded to be done.” ⁶Moses brought Aaron and his sons, and washed them with water. ⁷He put the tunic on him, tied the sash on him, clothed him with the robe, put the ephod on him, and he tied the skillfully woven band of the ephod on him and fastened it to him with it. ⁸He placed the breastplate on him. He put the Urim and Thummim in the breastplate. ⁹He set the turban on his head. He set the golden plate, the holy crown, on the front of the turban, as the LORD commanded Moses. ¹⁰Moses took the anointing oil, and anointed the tabernacle and all that was in it, and sanctified them. ¹¹He sprinkled it on the altar seven times, and anointed the altar and all its vessels, and the basin and its base, to sanctify them. ¹²He poured some of the anointing oil on Aaron’s head, and anointed him, to sanctify him. ¹³Moses brought Aaron’s sons, and clothed them with tunics, and tied sashes on them, and put headbands on them, as the LORD commanded Moses. ¹⁴He brought the bull of the sin offering, and Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the bull of the sin offering. ¹⁵He killed it; and Moses took the blood, and put it around on the horns of the altar with his finger, and purified the altar, and poured out the blood at the base of the altar, and sanctified it, to make atonement for it. ¹⁶He took all the fat that was on the innards, and the cover of the liver, and the two kidneys, and their fat; and Moses burned it on the altar. ¹⁷But the bull, and its skin, and its meat, and its dung, he burned with fire outside the camp, as the LORD commanded Moses. ¹⁸He presented the ram of the burnt offering. Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the ram. ¹⁹He killed it; and Moses sprinkled the blood around on the altar. ²⁰He cut the ram into its pieces; and Moses burned the head, and the pieces, and the fat. ²¹He washed the innards and the legs with water; and Moses burned the whole ram on the altar. It was a burnt offering for a pleasant aroma. It was an offering made by fire to the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses. ²²He presented the other ram, the ram of consecration. Aaron and his sons laid their hands on the head of the ram. ²³He killed it; and Moses took some of its blood, and put it on the tip of Aaron’s right ear, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the great toe of his right foot. ²⁴He brought Aaron’s sons; and Moses put some of the blood on the tip of their right ear, and on the thumb of their right hand, and on the great toe of their right foot; and Moses sprinkled the blood around on the altar. ²⁵He took the fat, the fat tail, all the fat that was on the innards, the cover of the liver, the two kidneys and their fat, and the right thigh; ²⁶and out of the basket of unleavened bread that was before the LORD, he took one unleavened cake, one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer,

and placed them on the fat and on the right thigh. ²⁷He put all these in Aaron's hands and in his sons' hands, and waved them for a wave offering before the LORD. ²⁸Moses took them from their hands, and burned them on the altar on the burnt offering. They were a consecration offering for a pleasant aroma. It was an offering made by fire to the LORD. ²⁹Moses took the breast, and waved it for a wave offering before the LORD. It was Moses' portion of the ram of consecration, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³⁰Moses took some of the anointing oil, and some of the blood which was on the altar, and sprinkled it on Aaron, on his garments, and on his sons, and on his sons' garments with him, and sanctified Aaron, his garments, and his sons, and his sons' garments with him. ³¹Moses said to Aaron and to his sons, "Boil the meat at the door of the Tent of Meeting, and there eat it and the bread that is in the basket of consecration, as I commanded, saying, 'Aaron and his sons shall eat it.' ³²What remains of the meat and of the bread you shall burn with fire. ³³You shall not go out from the door of the Tent of Meeting for seven days, until the days of your consecration are fulfilled: for he shall consecrate you seven days. ³⁴What has been done today, so the LORD has commanded to do, to make atonement for you. ³⁵You shall stay at the door of the Tent of Meeting day and night seven days, and keep the LORD's command, that you don't die: for so I am commanded." ³⁶Aaron and his sons did all the things which the LORD commanded by Moses.

⁹On the eighth day, Moses called Aaron and his sons, and the elders of Israel; ²and he said to Aaron, "Take a calf from the herd for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without defect, and offer them before the LORD. ³You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'Take a male goat for a sin offering; and a calf and a lamb, both a year old, without defect, for a burnt offering; ⁴and a bull and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before the LORD; and a meal offering mixed with oil: for today the LORD appears to you.' ⁵They brought what Moses commanded before the Tent of Meeting. All the congregation came near and stood before the LORD. ⁶Moses said, "This is the thing which the LORD commanded that you should do; and the LORD's glory shall appear to you." ⁷Moses said to Aaron, "Draw near to the altar, and offer your sin offering, and your burnt offering, and make atonement for yourself, and for the people; and offer the offering of the people, and make atonement for them, as the LORD commanded." ⁸So Aaron came near to the altar, and killed the calf of the sin offering, which was for himself. ⁹The sons of Aaron presented the blood to him; and he dipped his finger in the blood, and put it on the horns of the altar, and poured out the blood at the base of the altar; ¹⁰but the fat, and the kidneys, and the cover from the liver of the sin offering, he burned upon the altar, as the LORD commanded Moses.

¹¹The meat and the skin he burned with fire outside the camp. ¹²He killed the burnt offering; and Aaron's sons delivered the blood to him, and he sprinkled it around on the altar. ¹³They delivered the burnt offering to him, piece by piece, and the head. He burned them upon the altar. ¹⁴He washed the innards and the legs, and burned them on the burnt offering on the altar. ¹⁵He presented the people's offering, and took the goat of the sin offering which was for the people, and killed it, and offered it for sin, like the first. ¹⁶He presented the burnt offering, and offered it according to the ordinance. ¹⁷He presented the meal offering, and filled his hand from there, and burned it upon the altar, in addition to the burnt offering of the morning. ¹⁸He also killed the bull and the ram, the sacrifice of peace offerings, which was for the people. Aaron's sons delivered to him the blood, which he sprinkled around on the altar; ¹⁹and the fat of the bull and of the ram, the fat tail, and that which covers the innards, and the kidneys, and the cover of the liver; ²⁰and they put the fat upon the breasts, and he burned the fat on the altar. ²¹Aaron waved the breasts and the right thigh for a wave offering before the LORD, as Moses commanded. ²²Aaron lifted up his hands toward the people, and blessed them; and he came down from offering the sin offering, and the burnt offering, and the peace offerings. ²³Moses and Aaron went into the Tent of Meeting, and came out, and blessed the people; and the LORD's glory appeared to all the people. ²⁴Fire came out from before the LORD, and consumed the burnt offering and the fat upon the altar. When all the people saw it, they shouted, and fell on their faces.

¹⁰Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, each took his censer, and put fire in it, and laid incense on it, and offered strange fire before the LORD, which he had not commanded them. ²Fire came out from before the LORD, and devoured them, and they died before the LORD. ³Then Moses said to Aaron, "This is what the LORD spoke of, saying, 'I will show myself holy to those who come near me, and before all the people I will be glorified.'" Aaron held his peace. ⁴Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan, the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and said to them, "Draw near, carry your brothers from before the sanctuary out of the camp." ⁵So they came near, and carried them in their tunics out of the camp, as Moses had said. ⁶Moses said to Aaron, and to Eleazar and to Ithamar, his sons, "Don't let the hair of your heads go loose, and don't tear your clothes, so that you don't die, and so that he will not be angry with all the congregation; but let your brothers, the whole house of Israel, bewail the burning which the LORD has kindled. ⁷You shall not go out from the door of the Tent of Meeting, lest you die; for the anointing oil of the LORD is on you." They did according to the word of Moses. ⁸Then The LORD said to Aaron, ⁹"You and your sons are not to drink wine or strong drink whenever you

go into the Tent of Meeting, or you will die. This shall be a statute forever throughout your generations. ¹⁰You are to make a distinction between the holy and the common, and between the unclean and the clean. ¹¹You are to teach the children of Israel all the statutes which the LORD has spoken to them by Moses.” ¹²Moses spoke to Aaron, and to Eleazar and to Ithamar, his sons who were left, “Take the meal offering that remains of the offerings of the LORD made by fire, and eat it without yeast beside the altar; for it is most holy; ¹³and you shall eat it in a holy place, because it is your portion, and your sons’ portion, of the offerings of the LORD made by fire; for so I am commanded. ¹⁴The waved breast and the heaved thigh you shall eat in a clean place, you, and your sons, and your daughters with you: for they are given as your portion, and your sons’ portion, out of the sacrifices of the peace offerings of the children of Israel. ¹⁵They shall bring the heaved thigh and the waved breast with the offerings made by fire of the fat, to wave it for a wave offering before the LORD. It shall be yours, and your sons’ with you, as a portion forever, as the LORD has commanded.” ¹⁶Moses diligently inquired about the goat of the sin offering, and, behold, ^{vi} it was burned. He was angry with Eleazar and with Ithamar, the sons of Aaron who were left, saying, ¹⁷“Why haven’t you eaten the sin offering in the place of the sanctuary, since it is most holy, and he has given it to you to bear the iniquity of the congregation, to make atonement for them before the LORD? ¹⁸Behold, its blood was not brought into the inner part of the sanctuary. You certainly should have eaten it in the sanctuary, as I commanded.” ¹⁹Aaron spoke to Moses, “Behold, today they have offered their sin offering and their burnt offering before the LORD; and such things as these have happened to me. If I had eaten the sin offering today, would it have been pleasing in the LORD’s sight?” ²⁰When Moses heard that, it was pleasing in his sight.

11 The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying to them, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘These are the living things which you may eat among all the animals that are on the earth. ³Whatever parts the hoof, and is cloven-footed, and chews the cud among the animals, that you may eat. ⁴“Nevertheless these you shall not eat of those that chew the cud, or of those who part the hoof: the camel, because it chews the cud but doesn’t have a parted hoof, is unclean to you. ⁵The hyrax, ^{vii} because it chews the cud but doesn’t have a parted hoof, is unclean to you. ⁶The hare, because it chews the cud but doesn’t have a parted hoof, is unclean to you. ⁷The pig, because it has a split hoof, and is cloven-footed, but doesn’t chew the cud, is unclean to you. ⁸You shall not eat their meat. You

shall not touch their carcasses. They are unclean to you. ⁹“You may eat of all these that are in the waters: whatever has fins and scales in the waters, in the seas, and in the rivers, that you may eat. ¹⁰All that don’t have fins and scales in the seas and rivers, all that move in the waters, and all the living creatures that are in the waters, they are an abomination to you, ¹¹and you shall detest them. You shall not eat of their meat, and you shall detest their carcasses. ¹²Whatever has no fins nor scales in the waters is an abomination to you. ¹³“You shall detest these among the birds; they shall not be eaten because they are an abomination: the eagle, the vulture, the black vulture, ¹⁴the red kite, any kind of black kite, ¹⁵any kind of raven, ¹⁶the horned owl, the screech owl, the gull, any kind of hawk, ¹⁷the little owl, the cormorant, the great owl, ¹⁸the white owl, the desert owl, the osprey, ¹⁹the stork, any kind of heron, the hoopoe, and the bat. ²⁰“All flying insects that walk on all fours are an abomination to you. ²¹Yet you may eat these: of all winged creeping things that go on all fours, which have long, jointed legs for hopping on the earth. ²²Even of these you may eat: any kind of locust, any kind of katydid, any kind of cricket, and any kind of grasshopper. ²³But all winged creeping things which have four feet are an abomination to you. ²⁴“By these you will become unclean: whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening. ²⁵Whoever carries any part of their carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. ²⁶“Every animal which has a split hoof that isn’t completely divided, or doesn’t chew the cud, is unclean to you. Everyone who touches them shall be unclean. ²⁷Whatever goes on its paws, among all animals that go on all fours, they are unclean to you. Whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening. ²⁸He who carries their carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. They are unclean to you. ²⁹“These are they which are unclean to you among the creeping things that creep on the earth: the weasel, the rat, any kind of great lizard, ³⁰the gecko, and the monitor lizard, the wall lizard, the skink, and the chameleon. ³¹These are they which are unclean to you among all that creep. Whoever touches them when they are dead shall be unclean until the evening. ³²Anything they fall on when they are dead shall be unclean; whether it is any vessel of wood, or clothing, or skin, or sack, whatever vessel it is, with which any work is done, it must be put into water, and it shall be unclean until the evening. Then it will be clean. ³³Every earthen vessel into which any of them falls and all that is in it shall be unclean. You shall break it. ³⁴All food which may be eaten which is soaked in water shall be unclean. All drink that may be drunk in every such vessel shall be unclean. ³⁵Everything whereupon part of their carcass falls shall be unclean; whether oven, or range for pots, it shall be broken in pieces. They are unclean, and shall be unclean to you. ³⁶Nevertheless a spring or a cistern in which water

^{vi}“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{vii}or rock badger, or cony

is gathered shall be clean, but that which touches their carcass shall be unclean. ³⁷If part of their carcass falls on any sowing seed which is to be sown, it is clean. ³⁸But if water is put on the seed, and part of their carcass falls on it, it is unclean to you. ³⁹“If any animal of which you may eat dies, he who touches its carcass shall be unclean until the evening. ⁴⁰He who eats of its carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. He also who carries its carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. ⁴¹“Every creeping thing that creeps on the earth is an abomination. It shall not be eaten. ⁴²Whatever goes on its belly, and whatever goes on all fours, or whatever has many feet, even all creeping things that creep on the earth, them you shall not eat; for they are an abomination. ⁴³You shall not make yourselves abominable with any creeping thing that creeps. You shall not make yourselves unclean with them, that you should be defiled by them. ⁴⁴For I am the LORD your God. Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be holy; for I am holy. You shall not defile yourselves with any kind of creeping thing that moves on the earth. ⁴⁵For I am the LORD who brought you up out of the land of Egypt, to be your God. You shall therefore be holy, for I am holy. ⁴⁶“This is the law of the animal, and of the bird, and of every living creature that moves in the waters, and of every creature that creeps on the earth, ⁴⁷to make a distinction between the unclean and the clean, and between the living thing that may be eaten and the living thing that may not be eaten.”

12The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘If a woman conceives, and bears a male child, then she shall be unclean seven days; as in the days of her monthly period she shall be unclean. ³In the eighth day the flesh of his foreskin shall be circumcised. ⁴She shall continue in the blood of purification thirty-three days. She shall not touch any holy thing, nor come into the sanctuary, until the days of her purifying are completed. ⁵But if she bears a female child, then she shall be unclean two weeks, as in her period; and she shall continue in the blood of purification sixty-six days. ⁶“When the days of her purification are completed for a son or for a daughter, she shall bring to the priest at the door of the Tent of Meeting, a year old lamb for a burnt offering, and a young pigeon or a turtledove, for a sin offering. ⁷He shall offer it before the LORD, and make atonement for her; then she shall be cleansed from the fountain of her blood. “This is the law for her who bears, whether a male or a female. ⁸If she cannot afford a lamb, then she shall take two turtledoves or two young pigeons: the one for a burnt offering, and the other for a sin offering. The priest shall make atonement for her, and she shall be clean.”

13The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²“When a man shall have a swelling in his body’s skin, or

a scab, or a bright spot, and it becomes in the skin of his body the plague of leprosy, then he shall be brought to Aaron the priest or to one of his sons, the priests. ³The priest shall examine the plague in the skin of the body. If the hair in the plague has turned white, and the appearance of the plague is deeper than the body’s skin, it is the plague of leprosy; so the priest shall examine him and pronounce him unclean. ⁴If the bright spot is white in the skin of his body, and its appearance isn’t deeper than the skin, and its hair hasn’t turned white, then the priest shall isolate the infected person for seven days. ⁵The priest shall examine him on the seventh day. Behold, if in his eyes the plague is arrested and the plague hasn’t spread in the skin, then the priest shall isolate him for seven more days. ⁶The priest shall examine him again on the seventh day. Behold, if the plague has faded and the plague hasn’t spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. It is a scab. He shall wash his clothes, and be clean. ⁷But if the scab spreads on the skin after he has shown himself to the priest for his cleansing, he shall show himself to the priest again. ⁸The priest shall examine him; and behold, if the scab has spread on the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is leprosy. ⁹“When the plague of leprosy is in a man, then he shall be brought to the priest; ¹⁰and the priest shall examine him. Behold, if there is a white swelling in the skin, and it has turned the hair white, and there is raw flesh in the swelling, ¹¹it is a chronic leprosy in the skin of his body, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. He shall not isolate him, for he is already unclean. ¹²“If the leprosy breaks out all over the skin, and the leprosy covers all the skin of the infected person from his head even to his feet, as far as it appears to the priest, ¹³then the priest shall examine him. Behold, if the leprosy has covered all his flesh, he shall pronounce him clean of the plague. It has all turned white: he is clean. ¹⁴But whenever raw flesh appears in him, he shall be unclean. ¹⁵The priest shall examine the raw flesh, and pronounce him unclean: the raw flesh is unclean. It is leprosy. ¹⁶Or if the raw flesh turns again, and is changed to white, then he shall come to the priest. ¹⁷The priest shall examine him. Behold, if the plague has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him clean of the plague. He is clean. ¹⁸“When the body has a boil on its skin, and it has healed, ¹⁹and in the place of the boil there is a white swelling, or a bright spot, reddish-white, then it shall be shown to the priest. ²⁰The priest shall examine it. Behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and its hair has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. It has broken out in the boil. ²¹But if the priest examines it, and behold, there are no white hairs in it, and it isn’t deeper than the skin, but is dim, then the priest shall isolate him seven days. ²²If it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is a plague. ²³But if the bright spot stays in

its place, and hasn't spread, it is the scar from the boil; and the priest shall pronounce him clean. ²⁴"Or when the body has a burn from fire on its skin, and the raw flesh of the burn becomes a bright spot, reddish-white, or white, ²⁵then the priest shall examine it; and behold, if the hair in the bright spot has turned white, and its appearance is deeper than the skin, it is leprosy. It has broken out in the burning, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. ²⁶But if the priest examines it, and behold, there is no white hair in the bright spot, and it isn't deeper than the skin, but has faded, then the priest shall isolate him seven days. ²⁷The priest shall examine him on the seventh day. If it has spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. ²⁸If the bright spot stays in its place, and hasn't spread in the skin, but is faded, it is the swelling from the burn, and the priest shall pronounce him clean, for it is the scar from the burn. ²⁹"When a man or woman has a plague on the head or on the beard, ³⁰then the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and the hair in it is yellow and thin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is an itch. It is leprosy of the head or of the beard. ³¹If the priest examines the plague of itching, and behold, its appearance isn't deeper than the skin, and there is no black hair in it, then the priest shall isolate the person infected with itching seven days. ³²On the seventh day the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if the itch hasn't spread, and there is no yellow hair in it, and the appearance of the itch isn't deeper than the skin, ³³then he shall be shaved, but he shall not shave the itch. Then the priest shall isolate the one who has the itch seven more days. ³⁴On the seventh day, the priest shall examine the itch; and behold, if the itch hasn't spread in the skin, and its appearance isn't deeper than the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. He shall wash his clothes and be clean. ³⁵But if the itch spreads in the skin after his cleansing, ³⁶then the priest shall examine him; and behold, if the itch has spread in the skin, the priest shall not look for the yellow hair; he is unclean. ³⁷But if in his eyes the itch is arrested and black hair has grown in it, then the itch is healed. He is clean. The priest shall pronounce him clean. ³⁸"When a man or a woman has bright spots in the skin of the body, even white bright spots, ³⁹then the priest shall examine them. Behold, if the bright spots on the skin of their body are a dull white, it is a harmless rash. It has broken out in the skin. He is clean. ⁴⁰"If a man's hair has fallen from his head, he is bald. He is clean. ⁴¹If his hair has fallen off from the front part of his head, he is forehead bald. He is clean. ⁴²But if a reddish-white plague is in the bald head or the bald forehead, it is leprosy breaking out in his bald head or his bald forehead. ⁴³Then the priest shall examine him. Behold, if the swelling of the plague is reddish-white in his bald head, or in his bald forehead,

like the appearance of leprosy in the skin of the body, ⁴⁴he is a leprous man. He is unclean. The priest shall surely pronounce him unclean. His plague is on his head. ⁴⁵"The leper in whom the plague is shall wear torn clothes, and the hair of his head shall hang loose. He shall cover his upper lip, and shall cry, 'Unclean! Unclean!' ⁴⁶All the days in which the plague is in him he shall be unclean. He is unclean. He shall dwell alone. His dwelling shall be outside of the camp. ⁴⁷"The garment also that the plague of leprosy is in, whether it is a woolen garment, or a linen garment; ⁴⁸whether it is in warp or woof; ^{viii} of linen or of wool; whether in a leather, or in anything made of leather; ⁴⁹if the plague is greenish or reddish in the garment, or in the leather, or in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything made of leather; it is the plague of leprosy, and shall be shown to the priest. ⁵⁰The priest shall examine the plague, and isolate the plague seven days. ⁵¹He shall examine the plague on the seventh day. If the plague has spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in the skin, whatever use the skin is used for, the plague is a destructive mildew. It is unclean. ⁵²He shall burn the garment, whether the warp or the woof, in wool or in linen, or anything of leather, in which the plague is, for it is a destructive mildew. It shall be burned in the fire. ⁵³"If the priest examines it, and behold, the plague hasn't spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything of skin; ⁵⁴then the priest shall command that they wash the thing that the plague is in, and he shall isolate it seven more days. ⁵⁵Then the priest shall examine it, after the plague is washed; and behold, if the plague hasn't changed its color, and the plague hasn't spread, it is unclean; you shall burn it in the fire. It is a mildewed spot, whether the bareness is inside or outside. ⁵⁶If the priest looks, and behold, the plague has faded after it is washed, then he shall tear it out of the garment, or out of the skin, or out of the warp, or out of the woof; ⁵⁷and if it appears again in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything of skin, it is spreading. You shall burn what the plague is in with fire. ⁵⁸The garment, either the warp, or the woof, or whatever thing of skin it is, which you shall wash, if the plague has departed from them, then it shall be washed the second time, and it will be clean." ⁵⁹This is the law of the plague of mildew in a garment of wool or linen, either in the warp, or the woof, or in anything of skin, to pronounce it clean, or to pronounce it unclean.

14The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"This shall be the law of the leper in the day of his cleansing: He shall be brought to the priest, ³and the priest shall go out of the camp. The priest shall examine him. Behold, if the plague of leprosy is healed in the leper, ⁴then the priest shall command them to take for him who is to be cleansed

^{viii}warp and woof are the vertical and horizontal threads in woven cloth

two living clean birds, cedar wood, scarlet, and hyssop. ⁵The priest shall command them to kill one of the birds in an earthen vessel over running water. ⁶As for the living bird, he shall take it, the cedar wood, the scarlet, and the hyssop, and shall dip them and the living bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the running water. ⁷He shall sprinkle on him who is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird go into the open field. ⁸“He who is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes, and shave off all his hair, and bathe himself in water; and he shall be clean. After that he shall come into the camp, but shall dwell outside his tent seven days. ⁹It shall be on the seventh day, that he shall shave all his hair off his head and his beard and his eyebrows. He shall shave off all his hair. He shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his body in water. Then he shall be clean. ¹⁰“On the eighth day he shall take two male lambs without defect, one ewe lamb a year old without defect, three tenths of an ephah ^{ix} of fine flour for a meal offering, mixed with oil, and one log ^x of oil. ¹¹The priest who cleanses him shall set the man who is to be cleansed, and those things, before the LORD, at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ¹²“The priest shall take one of the male lambs, and offer him for a trespass offering, with the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. ¹³He shall kill the male lamb in the place where they kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, in the place of the sanctuary; for as the sin offering is the priest’s, so is the trespass offering. It is most holy. ¹⁴The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and the priest shall put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. ¹⁵The priest shall take some of the log of oil, and pour it into the palm of his own left hand. ¹⁶The priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle some of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD. ¹⁷The priest shall put some of the rest of the oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, upon the blood of the trespass offering. ¹⁸The rest of the oil that is in the priest’s hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, and the priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD. ¹⁹“The priest shall offer the sin offering, and make atonement for him who is to be cleansed because of his uncleanness. Afterward he shall kill the burnt offering; ²⁰then the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the meal offering on the altar. The priest shall make atonement for him, and he shall be clean. ²¹“If he is poor, and can’t afford so much, then he shall take one male lamb for a trespass offering to be waved, to

make atonement for him, and one tenth of an ephah ^{xi} of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering, and a log ^{xii} of oil; ²²and two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, such as he is able to afford; and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering. ²³“On the eighth day he shall bring them for his cleansing to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting, before the LORD. ²⁴The priest shall take the lamb of the trespass offering, and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. ²⁵He shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering. The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering and put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. ²⁶The priest shall pour some of the oil into the palm of his own left hand; ²⁷and the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his left hand seven times before the LORD. ²⁸Then the priest shall put some of the oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, on the place of the blood of the trespass offering. ²⁹The rest of the oil that is in the priest’s hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, to make atonement for him before the LORD. ³⁰He shall offer one of the turtledoves, or of the young pigeons, which ever he is able to afford, ³¹of the kind he is able to afford, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, with the meal offering. The priest shall make atonement for him who is to be cleansed before the LORD.” ³²This is the law for him in whom is the plague of leprosy, who is not able to afford the sacrifice for his cleansing. ³³The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ³⁴“When you have come into the land of Canaan, which I give to you for a possession, and I put a spreading mildew in a house in the land of your possession, ³⁵then he who owns the house shall come and tell the priest, saying, ‘There seems to me to be some sort of plague in the house.’ ³⁶The priest shall command that they empty the house, before the priest goes in to examine the plague, that all that is in the house not be made unclean. Afterward the priest shall go in to inspect the house. ³⁷He shall examine the plague; and behold, if the plague is in the walls of the house with hollow streaks, greenish or reddish, and it appears to be deeper than the wall, ³⁸then the priest shall go out of the house to the door of the house, and shut up the house seven days. ³⁹The priest shall come again on the seventh day, and look. If the plague has spread in the walls of the house, ⁴⁰then the priest shall command that they take out the stones in which is the plague, and cast them into an unclean place outside of the city. ⁴¹He shall cause the inside of the house to be scraped all over. They shall pour out the mortar that they scraped off outside

^{ix}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^xa log is a liquid measure of about 300 ml or 10 ounces

^{xi}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xii}a log is a liquid measure of about 300 ml or 10 ounces

of the city into an unclean place. ⁴²They shall take other stones, and put them in the place of those stones; and he shall take other mortar, and shall plaster the house. ⁴³"If the plague comes again, and breaks out in the house after he has taken out the stones, and after he has scraped the house, and after it was plastered, ⁴⁴then the priest shall come in and look; and behold, if the plague has spread in the house, it is a destructive mildew in the house. It is unclean. ⁴⁵He shall break down the house, its stones, and its timber, and all the house's mortar. He shall carry them out of the city into an unclean place. ⁴⁶"Moreover he who goes into the house while it is shut up shall be unclean until the evening. ⁴⁷He who lies down in the house shall wash his clothes; and he who eats in the house shall wash his clothes. ⁴⁸"If the priest shall come in, and examine it, and behold, the plague hasn't spread in the house, after the house was plastered, then the priest shall pronounce the house clean, because the plague is healed. ⁴⁹To cleanse the house he shall take two birds, cedar wood, scarlet, and hyssop. ⁵⁰He shall kill one of the birds in an earthen vessel over running water. ⁵¹He shall take the cedar wood, the hyssop, the scarlet, and the living bird, and dip them in the blood of the slain bird, and in the running water, and sprinkle the house seven times. ⁵²He shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird, and with the running water, with the living bird, with the cedar wood, with the hyssop, and with the scarlet; ⁵³but he shall let the living bird go out of the city into the open field. So shall he make atonement for the house; and it shall be clean." ⁵⁴This is the law for any plague of leprosy, and for an itch, ⁵⁵and for the destructive mildew of a garment, and for a house, ⁵⁶and for a swelling, and for a scab, and for a bright spot; ⁵⁷to teach when it is unclean, and when it is clean. This is the law of leprosy.

15The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²"Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, 'When any man has a discharge from his body, because of his discharge he is unclean. ³This shall be his uncleanness in his discharge: whether his body runs with his discharge, or his body has stopped from his discharge, it is his uncleanness. ⁴"Every bed on which he who has the discharge lies shall be unclean; and everything he sits on shall be unclean. ⁵Whoever touches his bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ⁶He who sits on anything on which the man who has the discharge sat shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ⁷"He who touches the body of him who has the discharge shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ⁸"If he who has the discharge spits on him who is clean, then he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ⁹"Whatever saddle he who has the discharge rides on shall be unclean. ¹⁰Whoever touches anything that was under

him shall be unclean until the evening. He who carries those things shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ¹¹"Whomever he who has the discharge touches, without having rinsed his hands in water, he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ¹²"The earthen vessel, which he who has the discharge touches, shall be broken; and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed in water. ¹³"When he who has a discharge is cleansed of his discharge, then he shall count to himself seven days for his cleansing, and wash his clothes; and he shall bathe his flesh in running water, and shall be clean. ¹⁴"On the eighth day he shall take two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and come before the LORD to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and give them to the priest. ¹⁵The priest shall offer them, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering. The priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD for his discharge. ¹⁶"If any man has an emission of semen, then he shall bathe all his flesh in water, and be unclean until the evening. ¹⁷Every garment and every skin which the semen is on shall be washed with water, and be unclean until the evening. ¹⁸If a man lies with a woman and there is an emission of semen, they shall both bathe themselves in water, and be unclean until the evening. ¹⁹"If a woman has a discharge, and her discharge in her flesh is blood, she shall be in her impurity seven days. Whoever touches her shall be unclean until the evening. ²⁰"Everything that she lies on in her impurity shall be unclean. Everything also that she sits on shall be unclean. ²¹Whoever touches her bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ²²Whoever touches anything that she sits on shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ²³If it is on the bed, or on anything she sits on, when he touches it, he shall be unclean until the evening. ²⁴"If any man lies with her, and her monthly flow is on him, he shall be unclean seven days; and every bed he lies on shall be unclean. ²⁵"If a woman has a discharge of her blood many days not in the time of her period, or if she has a discharge beyond the time of her period, all the days of the discharge of her uncleanness shall be as in the days of her period. She is unclean. ²⁶Every bed she lies on all the days of her discharge shall be to her as the bed of her period. Everything she sits on shall be unclean, as the uncleanness of her period. ²⁷Whoever touches these things shall be unclean, and shall wash his clothes and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. ²⁸"But if she is cleansed of her discharge, then she shall count to herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean. ²⁹On the eighth day she shall take two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and bring them to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting. ³⁰The priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make

atonement for her before the LORD for the uncleanness of her discharge. ³¹“Thus you shall separate the children of Israel from their uncleanness, so they will not die in their uncleanness when they defile my tabernacle that is among them.” ³²This is the law of him who has a discharge, and of him who has an emission of semen, so that he is unclean by it; ³³and of her who has her period, and of a man or woman who has a discharge, and of him who lies with her who is unclean.

¹⁶The LORD spoke to Moses after the death of the two sons of Aaron, when they came near before the LORD, and died; ²and the LORD said to Moses, “Tell Aaron your brother not to come at just any time into the Most Holy Place within the veil, before the mercy seat which is on the ark; lest he die; for I will appear in the cloud on the mercy seat. ³“Aaron shall come into the sanctuary with a young bull for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering. ⁴He shall put on the holy linen tunic. He shall have the linen trousers on his body, and shall put on the linen sash, and he shall be clothed with the linen turban. They are the holy garments. He shall bathe his body in water, and put them on. ⁵He shall take from the congregation of the children of Israel two male goats for a sin offering, and one ram for a burnt offering. ⁶“Aaron shall offer the bull of the sin offering, which is for himself, and make atonement for himself and for his house. ⁷He shall take the two goats, and set them before the LORD at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁸Aaron shall cast lots for the two goats: one lot for the LORD, and the other lot for the scapegoat. ⁹Aaron shall present the goat on which the lot fell for the LORD, and offer him for a sin offering. ¹⁰But the goat on which the lot fell for the scapegoat shall be presented alive before the LORD, to make atonement for him, to send him away as the scapegoat into the wilderness. ¹¹“Aaron shall present the bull of the sin offering, which is for himself, and shall make atonement for himself and for his house, and shall kill the bull of the sin offering which is for himself. ¹²He shall take a censer full of coals of fire from off the altar before the LORD, and two handfuls of sweet incense beaten small, and bring it within the veil. ¹³He shall put the incense on the fire before the LORD, that the cloud of the incense may cover the mercy seat that is on the covenant, so that he will not die. ¹⁴He shall take some of the blood of the bull, and sprinkle it with his finger on the mercy seat on the east; and before the mercy seat he shall sprinkle some of the blood with his finger seven times. ¹⁵“Then he shall kill the goat of the sin offering that is for the people, and bring his blood within the veil, and do with his blood as he did with the blood of the bull, and sprinkle it on the mercy seat and before the mercy seat. ¹⁶He shall make atonement for the Holy Place, because of the uncleanness of the children of Israel, and because of their transgressions, even all their

sins; and so he shall do for the Tent of Meeting that dwells with them in the middle of their uncleanness. ¹⁷No one shall be in the Tent of Meeting when he enters to make atonement in the Holy Place, until he comes out, and has made atonement for himself and for his household, and for all the assembly of Israel. ¹⁸“He shall go out to the altar that is before the LORD and make atonement for it, and shall take some of the bull’s blood, and some of the goat’s blood, and put it around on the horns of the altar. ¹⁹He shall sprinkle some of the blood on it with his finger seven times, and cleanse it, and make it holy from the uncleanness of the children of Israel. ²⁰“When he has finished atoning for the Holy Place, the Tent of Meeting, and the altar, he shall present the live goat. ²¹Aaron shall lay both his hands on the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions, even all their sins; and he shall put them on the head of the goat, and shall send him away into the wilderness by the hand of a man who is ready. ²²The goat shall carry all their iniquities on himself to a solitary land, and he shall release the goat in the wilderness. ²³“Aaron shall come into the Tent of Meeting, and shall take off the linen garments which he put on when he went into the Holy Place, and shall leave them there. ²⁴Then he shall bathe himself in water in a holy place, put on his garments, and come out and offer his burnt offering and the burnt offering of the people, and make atonement for himself and for the people. ²⁵The fat of the sin offering he shall burn on the altar. ²⁶“He who lets the goat go as the scapegoat shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp. ²⁷The bull for the sin offering, and the goat for the sin offering, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the Holy Place, shall be carried outside the camp; and they shall burn their skins, their flesh, and their dung with fire. ²⁸He who burns them shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp. ²⁹“It shall be a statute to you forever: in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, you shall afflict your souls, and shall do no kind of work, whether native-born or a stranger who lives as a foreigner among you; ³⁰for on this day shall atonement be made for you, to cleanse you. You shall be clean from all your sins before the LORD. ³¹It is a Sabbath of solemn rest to you, and you shall afflict your souls. It is a statute forever. ³²The priest, who is anointed and who is consecrated to be priest in his father’s place, shall make the atonement, and shall put on the linen garments, even the holy garments. ³³Then he shall make atonement for the Holy Sanctuary; and he shall make atonement for the Tent of Meeting and for the altar; and he shall make atonement for the priests and for all the people of the assembly. ³⁴“This shall be an everlasting statute for you, to make atonement for the children of Israel once in the year because of all their sins.” It was done as the LORD

commanded Moses.

17The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel, and say to them, ‘This is the thing which the LORD has commanded: ³Whatever man there is of the house of Israel who kills a bull, or lamb, or goat in the camp, or who kills it outside the camp, ⁴and hasn’t brought it to the door of the Tent of Meeting to offer it as an offering to the LORD before the LORD’s tabernacle: blood shall be imputed to that man. He has shed blood. That man shall be cut off from among his people. ⁵This is to the end that the children of Israel may bring their sacrifices, which they sacrifice in the open field, that they may bring them to the LORD, to the door of the Tent of Meeting, to the priest, and sacrifice them for sacrifices of peace offerings to the LORD. ⁶The priest shall sprinkle the blood on the LORD’s altar at the door of the Tent of Meeting, and burn the fat for a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ⁷They shall no more sacrifice their sacrifices to the goat idols, after which they play the prostitute. This shall be a statute forever to them throughout their generations.’ ⁸“You shall say to them, ‘Any man there is of the house of Israel, or of the strangers who live as foreigners among them, who offers a burnt offering or sacrifice, ⁹and doesn’t bring it to the door of the Tent of Meeting to sacrifice it to the LORD, that man shall be cut off from his people. ¹⁰“Any man of the house of Israel, or of the strangers who live as foreigners among them, who eats any kind of blood, I will set my face against that soul who eats blood, and will cut him off from among his people. ¹¹For the life of the flesh is in the blood. I have given it to you on the altar to make atonement for your souls; for it is the blood that makes atonement by reason of the life. ¹²Therefore I have said to the children of Israel, “No person among you may eat blood, nor may any stranger who lives as a foreigner among you eat blood.” ¹³“Whatever man there is of the children of Israel, or of the strangers who live as foreigners among them, who takes in hunting any animal or bird that may be eaten, he shall pour out its blood, and cover it with dust. ¹⁴For as to the life of all flesh, its blood is with its life. Therefore I said to the children of Israel, “You shall not eat the blood of any kind of flesh; for the life of all flesh is its blood. Whoever eats it shall be cut off.” ¹⁵“Every person that eats what dies of itself, or that which is torn by animals, whether he is native-born or a foreigner, shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. Then he shall be clean. ¹⁶But if he doesn’t wash them, or bathe his flesh, then he shall bear his iniquity.”

18The LORD said to Moses, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and say to them, ‘I am the LORD your God. ³You shall not do as they do in the land of Egypt, where you lived. You shall not do as they do in the land of

Canaan, where I am bringing you. You shall not follow their statutes. ⁴You shall do my ordinances. You shall keep my statutes and walk in them. I am the LORD your God. ⁵You shall therefore keep my statutes and my ordinances, which if a man does, he shall live in them. I am the LORD. ⁶“None of you shall approach any close relatives, to uncover their nakedness: I am the LORD. ⁷“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your father, nor the nakedness of your mother: she is your mother. You shall not uncover her nakedness. ⁸“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your father’s wife. It is your father’s nakedness. ⁹“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your sister, the daughter of your father, or the daughter of your mother, whether born at home or born abroad. ¹⁰“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your son’s daughter, or of your daughter’s daughter, even their nakedness; for theirs is your own nakedness. ¹¹“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your father’s wife’s daughter, conceived by your father, since she is your sister. ¹²“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your father’s sister. She is your father’s near kinswoman. ¹³“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your mother’s sister, for she is your mother’s near kinswoman. ¹⁴“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your father’s brother. You shall not approach his wife. She is your aunt. ¹⁵“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your daughter-in-law. She is your son’s wife. You shall not uncover her nakedness. ¹⁶“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your brother’s wife. It is your brother’s nakedness. ¹⁷“You shall not uncover the nakedness of a woman and her daughter. You shall not take her son’s daughter, or her daughter’s daughter, to uncover her nakedness. They are near kinswomen. It is wickedness. ¹⁸“You shall not take a wife in addition to her sister, to be a rival, to uncover her nakedness, while her sister is still alive. ¹⁹“You shall not approach a woman to uncover her nakedness, as long as she is impure by her uncleanness. ²⁰“You shall not lie carnally with your neighbor’s wife, and defile yourself with her. ²¹“You shall not give any of your children as a sacrifice to Molech. You shall not profane the name of your God. I am the LORD. ²²“You shall not lie with a man as with a woman. That is detestable. ²³“You shall not lie with any animal to defile yourself with it. No woman may give herself to an animal, to lie down with it: it is a perversion. ²⁴“Don’t defile yourselves in any of these things; for in all these the nations which I am casting out before you were defiled. ²⁵The land was defiled. Therefore I punished its iniquity, and the land vomited out her inhabitants. ²⁶You therefore shall keep my statutes and my ordinances, and shall not do any of these abominations; neither the native-born, nor the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you ²⁷(for the men of the land that were before you had done all these abominations, and the land became defiled), ²⁸that the land not vomit you out also, when you defile it, as it vomited out the nation that was

before you. ²⁹“For whoever shall do any of these abominations, even the souls that do them shall be cut off from among their people. ³⁰Therefore you shall keep my requirements, that you do not practice any of these abominable customs which were practiced before you, and that you do not defile yourselves with them. I am the LORD your God.”

19The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to all the congregation of the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘You shall be holy; for I, the LORD your God, am holy. ³“Each one of you shall respect his mother and his father. You shall keep my Sabbaths. I am the LORD your God. ⁴“Don’t turn to idols, nor make molten gods for yourselves. I am the LORD your God. ⁵“When you offer a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD, you shall offer it so that you may be accepted. ⁶It shall be eaten the same day you offer it, and on the next day. If anything remains until the third day, it shall be burned with fire. ⁷If it is eaten at all on the third day, it is an abomination. It will not be accepted; ⁸but everyone who eats it shall bear his iniquity, because he has profaned the holy thing of the LORD, and that soul shall be cut off from his people. ⁹“When you reap the harvest of your land, you shall not wholly reap the corners of your field, neither shall you gather the gleanings of your harvest. ¹⁰You shall not glean your vineyard, neither shall you gather the fallen grapes of your vineyard. You shall leave them for the poor and for the foreigner. I am the LORD your God. ¹¹“You shall not steal. “You shall not lie. “You shall not deceive one another. ¹²“You shall not swear by my name falsely, and profane the name of your God. I am the LORD. ¹³“You shall not oppress your neighbor, nor rob him. “The wages of a hired servant shall not remain with you all night until the morning. ¹⁴“You shall not curse the deaf, nor put a stumbling block before the blind; but you shall fear your God. I am the LORD. ¹⁵“You shall do no injustice in judgment. You shall not be partial to the poor, nor show favoritism to the great; but you shall judge your neighbor in righteousness. ¹⁶“You shall not go around as a slanderer among your people. “You shall not endanger the life ^{xiii} of your neighbor. I am the LORD. ¹⁷“You shall not hate your brother in your heart. You shall surely rebuke your neighbor, and not bear sin because of him. ¹⁸“You shall not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of your people; but you shall love your neighbor as yourself. I am the LORD. ¹⁹“You shall keep my statutes. “You shall not cross-breed different kinds of animals. “You shall not sow your field with two kinds of seed; “Don’t wear a garment made of two kinds of material. ²⁰“If a man lies carnally with a woman who is a slave girl, pledged to be married to another man, and not ransomed or given her freedom; they shall be punished. They shall not be put to death, because

she was not free. ²¹He shall bring his trespass offering to the LORD, to the door of the Tent of Meeting, even a ram for a trespass offering. ²²The priest shall make atonement for him with the ram of the trespass offering before the LORD for his sin which he has committed; and the sin which he has committed shall be forgiven him. ²³“When you come into the land, and have planted all kinds of trees for food, then you shall count their fruit as forbidden. ^{xiv} For three years it shall be forbidden to you. It shall not be eaten. ²⁴But in the fourth year all its fruit shall be holy, for giving praise to the LORD. ²⁵In the fifth year you shall eat its fruit, that it may yield its increase to you. I am the LORD your God. ²⁶“You shall not eat any meat with the blood still in it. You shall not use enchantments, nor practice sorcery. ²⁷“You shall not cut the hair on the sides of your head or clip off the edge of your beard. ²⁸“You shall not make any cuttings in your flesh for the dead, nor tattoo any marks on you. I am the LORD. ²⁹“Don’t profane your daughter, to make her a prostitute; lest the land fall to prostitution, and the land become full of wickedness. ³⁰“You shall keep my Sabbaths, and reverence my sanctuary; I am the LORD. ³¹“Don’t turn to those who are mediums, nor to the wizards. Don’t seek them out, to be defiled by them. I am the LORD your God. ³²“You shall rise up before the gray head and honor the face of the elderly; and you shall fear your God. I am the LORD. ³³“If a stranger lives as a foreigner with you in your land, you shall not do him wrong. ³⁴The stranger who lives as a foreigner with you shall be to you as the native-born among you, and you shall love him as yourself; for you lived as foreigners in the land of Egypt. I am the LORD your God. ³⁵“You shall do no unrighteousness in judgment, in measures of length, of weight, or of quantity. ³⁶You shall have just balances, just weights, a just ephah, ^{xv} and a just hin. ^{xvi} I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt. ³⁷“You shall observe all my statutes and all my ordinances, and do them. I am the LORD.”

20The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Moreover, you shall tell the children of Israel, ‘Anyone of the children of Israel, or of the strangers who live as foreigners in Israel, who gives any of his offspring ^{xvii} to Molech shall surely be put to death. The people of the land shall stone that person with stones. ³I also will set my face against that person, and will cut him off from among his people, because he has given of his offspring to Molech, to defile my sanctuary, and to profane my holy name. ⁴If the people of the land all hide their eyes from that person when he gives of his offspring to Molech, and don’t put him to death, ⁵then I will set my face against that man and against his

^{xiii}literally, “blood”

^{xiv}literally, “uncircumcised”

^{xv}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xvi}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

^{xvii}or, seed

family, and will cut him off, and all who play the prostitute after him to play the prostitute with Molech, from among their people. ⁶“The person that turns to those who are mediums and wizards, to play the prostitute after them, I will even set my face against that person, and will cut him off from among his people. ⁷“Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be holy; for I am the LORD your God. ⁸You shall keep my statutes, and do them. I am the LORD who sanctifies you. ⁹“For everyone who curses his father or his mother shall surely be put to death. He has cursed his father or his mother. His blood shall be upon himself. ¹⁰“The man who commits adultery with another man’s wife, even he who commits adultery with his neighbor’s wife, the adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death. ¹¹“The man who lies with his father’s wife has uncovered his father’s nakedness. Both of them shall surely be put to death. Their blood shall be upon themselves. ¹²“If a man lies with his daughter-in-law, both of them shall surely be put to death. They have committed a perversion. Their blood shall be upon themselves. ¹³“If a man lies with a male, as with a woman, both of them have committed an abomination. They shall surely be put to death. Their blood shall be upon themselves. ¹⁴“If a man takes a wife and her mother, it is wickedness. They shall be burned with fire, both he and they, that there may be no wickedness among you. ¹⁵“If a man lies with an animal, he shall surely be put to death; and you shall kill the animal. ¹⁶“If a woman approaches any animal and lies with it, you shall kill the woman and the animal. They shall surely be put to death. Their blood shall be upon them. ¹⁷“If a man takes his sister—his father’s daughter, or his mother’s daughter—and sees her nakedness, and she sees his nakedness, it is a shameful thing. They shall be cut off in the sight of the children of their people. He has uncovered his sister’s nakedness. He shall bear his iniquity. ¹⁸“If a man lies with a woman having her monthly period, and uncovers her nakedness, he has made her fountain naked, and she has uncovered the fountain of her blood. Both of them shall be cut off from among their people. ¹⁹“You shall not uncover the nakedness of your mother’s sister, nor of your father’s sister, for he has made his close relative naked. They shall bear their iniquity. ²⁰If a man lies with his uncle’s wife, he has uncovered his uncle’s nakedness. They shall bear their sin. They shall die childless. ²¹“If a man takes his brother’s wife, it is an impurity. He has uncovered his brother’s nakedness. They shall be childless. ²²“You shall therefore keep all my statutes and all my ordinances, and do them, that the land where I am bringing you to dwell may not vomit you out. ²³You shall not walk in the customs of the nation which I am casting out before you; for they did all these things, and therefore I abhorred them. ²⁴But I have said to you, “You shall inherit their land, and I will give it to you to possess it, a land flowing with milk and honey.”

I am the LORD your God, who has separated you from the peoples. ²⁵“You shall therefore make a distinction between the clean animal and the unclean, and between the unclean fowl and the clean. You shall not make yourselves abominable by animal, or by bird, or by anything with which the ground teems, which I have separated from you as unclean for you. ²⁶You shall be holy to me, for I, the LORD, am holy, and have set you apart from the peoples, that you should be mine. ²⁷“A man or a woman that is a medium or is a wizard shall surely be put to death. They shall be stoned with stones. Their blood shall be upon themselves.”

21 The LORD said to Moses, “Speak to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and say to them, ‘A priest shall not defile himself for the dead among his people, ²except for his relatives that are near to him: for his mother, for his father, for his son, for his daughter, for his brother, ³and for his virgin sister who is near to him, who has had no husband; for her he may defile himself. ⁴He shall not defile himself, being a chief man among his people, to profane himself. ⁵“They shall not shave their heads or shave off the corners of their beards or make any cuttings in their flesh. ⁶They shall be holy to their God, and not profane the name of their God, for they offer the offerings of the LORD made by fire, the bread of their God. Therefore they shall be holy. ⁷“They shall not marry a woman who is a prostitute, or profane. A priest shall not marry a woman divorced from her husband; for he is holy to his God. ⁸Therefore you shall sanctify him, for he offers the bread of your God. He shall be holy to you, for I the LORD, who sanctify you, am holy. ⁹“The daughter of any priest, if she profanes herself by playing the prostitute, she profanes her father. She shall be burned with fire. ¹⁰“He who is the high priest among his brothers, upon whose head the anointing oil is poured, and who is consecrated to put on the garments, shall not let the hair of his head hang loose, or tear his clothes. ¹¹He must not go in to any dead body, or defile himself for his father or for his mother. ¹²He shall not go out of the sanctuary, nor profane the sanctuary of his God; for the crown of the anointing oil of his God is upon him. I am the LORD. ¹³“He shall take a wife in her virginity. ¹⁴He shall not marry a widow, or one divorced, or a woman who has been defiled, or a prostitute. He shall take a virgin of his own people as a wife. ¹⁵He shall not profane his offspring among his people, for I am the LORD who sanctifies him.” ¹⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁷“Say to Aaron, ‘None of your offspring throughout their generations who has a defect may approach to offer the bread of his God. ¹⁸For whatever man he is that has a defect, he shall not draw near: a blind man, or a lame, or he who has a flat nose, or any deformity, ¹⁹or a man who has an injured foot, or an injured hand, ²⁰or hunchbacked, or a dwarf, or one who has a defect in his eye, or an itching

disease, or scabs, or who has damaged testicles. ²¹No man of the offspring of Aaron the priest who has a defect shall come near to offer the offerings of the LORD made by fire. Since he has a defect, he shall not come near to offer the bread of his God. ²²He shall eat the bread of his God, both of the most holy, and of the holy. ²³He shall not come near to the veil, nor come near to the altar, because he has a defect; that he may not profane my sanctuaries, for I am the LORD who sanctifies them.” ²⁴So Moses spoke to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel.

22The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Tell Aaron and his sons to separate themselves from the holy things of the children of Israel, which they make holy to me, and that they not profane my holy name. I am the LORD. ³“Tell them, ‘If anyone of all your offspring throughout your generations approaches the holy things which the children of Israel make holy to the LORD, having his uncleanness on him, that soul shall be cut off from before me. I am the LORD. ⁴“Whoever of the offspring of Aaron is a leper or has a discharge shall not eat of the holy things until he is clean. Whoever touches anything that is unclean by the dead, or a man who has a seminal emission, ⁵or whoever touches any creeping thing by which he may be made unclean, or a man from whom he may become unclean, whatever uncleanness he has— ⁶the person that touches any such shall be unclean until the evening, and shall not eat of the holy things unless he bathes his body in water. ⁷When the sun is down, he shall be clean; and afterward he shall eat of the holy things, because it is his bread. ⁸He shall not eat that which dies of itself or is torn by animals, defiling himself by it. I am the LORD. ⁹“They shall therefore follow my commandment, lest they bear sin for it and die in it, if they profane it. I am the LORD who sanctifies them. ¹⁰“No stranger shall eat of the holy thing: a foreigner living with the priests, or a hired servant, shall not eat of the holy thing. ¹¹But if a priest buys a slave, purchased by his money, he shall eat of it; and those who are born in his house shall eat of his bread. ¹²If a priest’s daughter is married to an outsider, she shall not eat of the heave offering of the holy things. ¹³But if a priest’s daughter is a widow, or divorced, and has no child, and has returned to her father’s house as in her youth, she may eat of her father’s bread; but no stranger shall eat any of it. ¹⁴“If a man eats something holy unwittingly, then he shall add the fifth part of its value to it, and shall give the holy thing to the priest. ¹⁵The priests shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, which they offer to the LORD, ¹⁶and so cause them to bear the iniquity that brings guilt when they eat their holy things; for I am the LORD who sanctifies them.” ¹⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁸“Speak to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel, and say to them, ‘Whoever is of the house of Israel, or of the foreigners in Israel, who

offers his offering, whether it is any of their vows or any of their free will offerings, which they offer to the LORD for a burnt offering: ¹⁹that you may be accepted, you shall offer a male without defect, of the bulls, of the sheep, or of the goats. ²⁰But you shall not offer whatever has a defect, for it shall not be acceptable for you. ²¹Whoever offers a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD to accomplish a vow, or for a free will offering of the herd or of the flock, it shall be perfect to be accepted. It shall have no defect. ²²You shall not offer what is blind, is injured, is maimed, has a wart, is festering, or has a running sore to the LORD, nor make an offering by fire of them on the altar to the LORD. ²³Either a bull or a lamb that has any deformity or lacking in his parts, that you may offer for a free will offering; but for a vow it shall not be accepted. ²⁴You must not offer to the LORD that which has its testicles bruised, crushed, broken, or cut. You must not do this in your land. ²⁵You must not offer any of these as the bread of your God from the hand of a foreigner, because their corruption is in them. There is a defect in them. They shall not be accepted for you.” ²⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁷“When a bull, a sheep, or a goat is born, it shall remain seven days with its mother. From the eighth day on it shall be accepted for the offering of an offering made by fire to the LORD. ²⁸Whether it is a cow or ewe, you shall not kill it and its young both in one day. ²⁹“When you sacrifice a sacrifice of thanksgiving to the LORD, you shall sacrifice it so that you may be accepted. ³⁰It shall be eaten on the same day; you shall leave none of it until the morning. I am the LORD. ³¹“Therefore you shall keep my commandments, and do them. I am the LORD. ³²You shall not profane my holy name, but I will be made holy among the children of Israel. I am the LORD who makes you holy, ³³who brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God. I am the LORD.”

23The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘The set feasts of the LORD, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts. ³“Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest, a holy convocation; you shall do no kind of work. It is a Sabbath to the LORD in all your dwellings. ⁴“These are the set feasts of the LORD, even holy convocations, which you shall proclaim in their appointed season. ⁵In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month in the evening, is the LORD’s Passover. ⁶On the fifteenth day of the same month is the feast of unleavened bread to the LORD. Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread. ⁷In the first day you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work. ⁸But you shall offer an offering made by fire to the LORD seven days. In the seventh day is a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.” ⁹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁰“Speak to the children of Israel, and

tell them, ‘When you have come into the land which I give to you, and shall reap its harvest, then you shall bring the sheaf of the first fruits of your harvest to the priest. ¹¹He shall wave the sheaf before the LORD, to be accepted for you. On the next day after the Sabbath the priest shall wave it. ¹²On the day when you wave the sheaf, you shall offer a male lamb without defect a year old for a burnt offering to the LORD. ¹³The meal offering with it shall be two tenths of an efa^{xviii} of fine flour mixed with oil, an offering made by fire to the LORD for a pleasant aroma; and the drink offering with it shall be of wine, the fourth part of a hin. ^{xix} ¹⁴You must not eat bread, or roasted grain, or fresh grain, until this same day, until you have brought the offering of your God. This is a statute forever throughout your generations in all your dwellings. ¹⁵“You shall count from the next day after the Sabbath, from the day that you brought the sheaf of the wave offering: seven Sabbaths shall be completed. ¹⁶The next day after the seventh Sabbath you shall count fifty days; and you shall offer a new meal offering to the LORD. ¹⁷You shall bring out of your habitations two loaves of bread for a wave offering made of two tenths of an efa^{xx} of fine flour. They shall be baked with yeast, for first fruits to the LORD. ¹⁸You shall present with the bread seven lambs without defect a year old, one young bull, and two rams. They shall be a burnt offering to the LORD, with their meal offering and their drink offerings, even an offering made by fire, of a sweet aroma to the LORD. ¹⁹You shall offer one male goat for a sin offering, and two male lambs a year old for a sacrifice of peace offerings. ²⁰The priest shall wave them with the bread of the first fruits for a wave offering before the LORD, with the two lambs. They shall be holy to the LORD for the priest. ²¹You shall make proclamation on the same day that there shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall do no regular work. This is a statute forever in all your dwellings throughout your generations. ²²“When you reap the harvest of your land, you must not wholly reap into the corners of your field. You must not gather the gleanings of your harvest. You must leave them for the poor and for the foreigner. I am the LORD your God.” ²³The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁴“Speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, there shall be a solemn rest for you, a memorial of blowing of shofars ^{xxi}, or, trumpets a holy convocation. ²⁵You shall do no regular work. You shall offer an offering made by fire to the LORD.’” ²⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁷“However on the tenth day of this seventh month is Yom Kippur. It shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall afflict yourselves and you shall offer an offering made by fire to the LORD. ²⁸You shall

do no kind of work in that same day, for it is Yom Kippur ^{xxii}, a day of atonement to make atonement for you before the LORD your God. ²⁹For whoever it is who shall not deny himself in that same day shall be cut off from his people. ³⁰Whoever does any kind of work in that same day, I will destroy that person from among his people. ³¹You shall do no kind of work: it is a statute forever throughout your generations in all your dwellings. ³²It shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest for you, and you shall deny yourselves. In the ninth day of the month at evening, from evening to evening, you shall keep your Sabbath.” ³³The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ³⁴“Speak to the children of Israel, and say, ‘On the fifteenth day of this seventh month is the feast of booths ^{xxiii} for seven days to the LORD. ³⁵On the first day shall be a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work. ³⁶Seven days you shall offer an offering made by fire to the LORD. On the eighth day shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall offer an offering made by fire to the LORD. It is a solemn assembly; you shall do no regular work. ³⁷“These are the appointed feasts of the LORD which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, to offer an offering made by fire to the LORD, a burnt offering, a meal offering, a sacrifice, and drink offerings, each on its own day— ³⁸in addition to the Sabbaths of the LORD, and in addition to your gifts, and in addition to all your vows, and in addition to all your free will offerings, which you give to the LORD. ³⁹“So on the fifteenth day of the seventh month, when you have gathered in the fruits of the land, you shall keep the feast of the LORD seven days. On the first day shall be a solemn rest, and on the eighth day shall be a solemn rest. ⁴⁰You shall take on the first day the fruit of majestic trees, branches of palm trees, and boughs of thick trees, and willows of the brook; and you shall rejoice before the LORD your God seven days. ⁴¹You shall keep it as a feast to the LORD seven days in the year. It is a statute forever throughout your generations. You shall keep it in the seventh month. ⁴²You shall dwell in temporary shelters ^{xxiv} for seven days. All who are native-born in Israel shall dwell in temporary shelters, ^{xxv} ⁴³that your generations may know that I made the children of Israel to dwell in temporary shelters ^{xxvi} when I brought them out of the land of Egypt. I am the LORD your God.” ⁴⁴So Moses declared to the children of Israel the appointed feasts of the LORD.

24The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Command the children of Israel, that they bring to you pure olive oil beaten for the light, to cause a lamp to burn continually. ³Outside of the veil of the Testimony, in the Tent of Meet-

^{xviii}1 efa is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xix}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

^{xx}1 efa is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxi}or, trumpets,

^{xxii}a day of atonement,

^{xxiii}or, feast of booths, or Succoth

^{xxiv}or, booths

^{xxv}or, booths

^{xxvi}or, booths

ing, Aaron shall keep it in order from evening to morning before the LORD continually. It shall be a statute forever throughout your generations. ⁴He shall keep in order the lamps on the pure gold lamp stand before the LORD continually. ⁵“You shall take fine flour, and bake twelve cakes of it: two tenths of an ephah ^{xxvii} shall be in one cake. ⁶You shall set them in two rows, six on a row, on the pure gold table before the LORD. ⁷You shall put pure frankincense on each row, that it may be to the bread for a memorial, even an offering made by fire to the LORD. ⁸Every Sabbath day he shall set it in order before the LORD continually. It is an everlasting covenant on the behalf of the children of Israel. ⁹It shall be for Aaron and his sons. They shall eat it in a holy place; for it is most holy to him of the offerings of the LORD made by fire by a perpetual statute.” ¹⁰The son of an Israelite woman, whose father was an Egyptian, went out among the children of Israel; and the son of the Israelite woman and a man of Israel strove together in the camp. ¹¹The son of the Israelite woman blasphemed the Name, and cursed; and they brought him to Moses. His mother’s name was Shelomith, the daughter of Dibri, of the tribe of Dan. ¹²They put him in custody until the LORD’s will should be declared to them. ¹³The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁴“Bring him who cursed out of the camp; and let all who heard him lay their hands on his head, and let all the congregation stone him. ¹⁵You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘Whoever curses his God shall bear his sin. ¹⁶He who blasphemes the LORD’s name, he shall surely be put to death. All the congregation shall certainly stone him. The foreigner as well as the native-born shall be put to death when he blasphemes the Name. ¹⁷“He who strikes any man mortally shall surely be put to death. ¹⁸He who strikes an animal mortally shall make it good, life for life. ¹⁹If anyone injures his neighbor, it shall be done to him as he has done: ²⁰fracture for fracture, eye for eye, tooth for tooth. It shall be done to him as he has injured someone. ²¹He who kills an animal shall make it good; and he who kills a man shall be put to death. ²²You shall have one kind of law for the foreigner as well as the native-born; for I am the LORD your God.’” ²³Moses spoke to the children of Israel; and they brought him who had cursed out of the camp, and stoned him with stones. The children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses.

²⁵The LORD said to Moses on Mount Sinai, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘When you come into the land which I give you, then the land shall keep a Sabbath to the LORD. ³You shall sow your field six years, and you shall prune your vineyard six years, and gather in its fruits; ⁴but in the seventh year there shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest for the land, a Sabbath to the LORD. You shall not sow your field or prune your vineyard. ⁵What grows of itself in your harvest you shall not reap, and you

shall not gather the grapes of your undressed vine. It shall be a year of solemn rest for the land. ⁶The Sabbath of the land shall be for food for you; for yourself, for your servant, for your maid, for your hired servant, and for your stranger, who lives as a foreigner with you. ⁷For your livestock also, and for the animals that are in your land, shall all its increase be for food. ⁸“You shall count off seven Sabbaths of years, seven times seven years; and there shall be to you the days of seven Sabbaths of years, even forty-nine years. ⁹Then you shall sound the loud shofar on the tenth day of the seventh month. On the Day of Atonement you shall sound the shofar throughout all your land. ¹⁰You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you; and each of you shall return to his own property, and each of you shall return to his family. ¹¹That fiftieth year shall be a jubilee to you. In it you shall not sow, neither reap that which grows of itself, nor gather from the undressed vines. ¹²For it is a jubilee; it shall be holy to you. You shall eat of its increase out of the field. ¹³“In this Year of Jubilee each of you shall return to his property. ¹⁴“If you sell anything to your neighbor, or buy from your neighbor, you shall not wrong one another. ¹⁵According to the number of years after the Jubilee you shall buy from your neighbor. According to the number of years of the crops he shall sell to you. ¹⁶According to the length of the years you shall increase its price, and according to the shortness of the years you shall diminish its price; for he is selling the number of the crops to you. ¹⁷You shall not wrong one another, but you shall fear your God; for I am the LORD your God. ¹⁸“Therefore you shall do my statutes, and keep my ordinances and do them; and you shall dwell in the land in safety. ¹⁹The land shall yield its fruit, and you shall eat your fill, and dwell therein in safety. ²⁰If you said, ‘What shall we eat the seventh year? Behold, we shall not sow, nor gather in our increase;’ ²¹then I will command my blessing on you in the sixth year, and it shall bear fruit for the three years. ²²You shall sow the eighth year, and eat of the fruits from the old store until the ninth year. Until its fruits come in, you shall eat the old store. ²³“The land shall not be sold in perpetuity, for the land is mine; for you are strangers and live as foreigners with me. ²⁴In all the land of your possession you shall grant a redemption for the land. ²⁵“If your brother becomes poor, and sells some of his possessions, then his kinsman who is next to him shall come, and redeem that which his brother has sold. ²⁶If a man has no one to redeem it, and he becomes prosperous and finds sufficient means to redeem it, ²⁷then let him reckon the years since its sale, and restore the surplus to the man to whom he sold it; and he shall return to his property. ²⁸But if he isn’t able to get it back for himself, then what he has sold shall remain in the hand of him who has bought it until the Year of Jubilee. In the Jubilee it shall be released, and he shall return to his property. ²⁹“If

^{xxvii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

a man sells a dwelling house in a walled city, then he may redeem it within a whole year after it has been sold. For a full year he shall have the right of redemption. ³⁰If it isn't redeemed within the space of a full year, then the house that is in the walled city shall be made sure in perpetuity to him who bought it, throughout his generations. It shall not be released in the Jubilee. ³¹But the houses of the villages which have no wall around them shall be accounted for with the fields of the country: they may be redeemed, and they shall be released in the Jubilee. ³²"Nevertheless, in the cities of the Levites, the Levites may redeem the houses in the cities of their possession at any time. ³³The Levites may redeem the house that was sold, and the city of his possession, and it shall be released in the Jubilee; for the houses of the cities of the Levites are their possession among the children of Israel. ³⁴But the field of the pasture lands of their cities may not be sold, for it is their perpetual possession. ³⁵"If your brother has become poor, and his hand can't support himself among you, then you shall uphold him. He shall live with you like an alien and a temporary resident. ³⁶Take no interest from him or profit; but fear your God, that your brother may live among you. ³⁷You shall not lend him your money at interest, nor give him your food for profit. ³⁸I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, to give you the land of Canaan, and to be your God. ³⁹"If your brother has grown poor among you, and sells himself to you, you shall not make him to serve as a slave. ⁴⁰As a hired servant, and as a temporary resident, he shall be with you; he shall serve with you until the Year of Jubilee. ⁴¹Then he shall go out from you, he and his children with him, and shall return to his own family, and to the possession of his fathers. ⁴²For they are my servants, whom I brought out of the land of Egypt. They shall not be sold as slaves. ⁴³You shall not rule over him with harshness, but shall fear your God. ⁴⁴"As for your male and your female slaves, whom you may have from the nations that are around you, from them you may buy male and female slaves. ⁴⁵Moreover, of the children of the aliens who live among you, of them you may buy, and of their families who are with you, which they have conceived in your land; and they will be your property. ⁴⁶You may make them an inheritance for your children after you, to hold for a possession. Of them you may take your slaves forever, but over your brothers the children of Israel you shall not rule, one over another, with harshness. ⁴⁷"If an alien or temporary resident with you becomes rich, and your brother beside him has grown poor, and sells himself to the stranger or foreigner living among you, or to a member of the stranger's family, ⁴⁸after he is sold he may be redeemed. One of his brothers may redeem him; ⁴⁹or his uncle, or his uncle's son, may redeem him, or any who is a close relative to him of his family may redeem him; or if he has grown rich, he may redeem himself. ⁵⁰He shall reckon with him who bought him from the year that

he sold himself to him to the Year of Jubilee. The price of his sale shall be according to the number of years; he shall be with him according to the time of a hired servant. ⁵¹If there are yet many years, according to them he shall give back the price of his redemption out of the money that he was bought for. ⁵²If there remain but a few years to the year of jubilee, then he shall reckon with him; according to his years of service he shall give back the price of his redemption. ⁵³As a servant hired year by year shall he be with him. He shall not rule with harshness over him in your sight. ⁵⁴If he isn't redeemed by these means, then he shall be released in the Year of Jubilee: he and his children with him. ⁵⁵For to me the children of Israel are servants; they are my servants whom I brought out of the land of Egypt. I am the LORD your God.

26"You shall make for yourselves no idols, and you shall not raise up a carved image or a pillar, and you shall not place any figured stone in your land, to bow down to it; for I am the LORD your God. ²"You shall keep my Sabbaths, and have reverence for my sanctuary. I am the LORD. ³"If you walk in my statutes and keep my commandments, and do them, ⁴then I will give you your rains in their season, and the land shall yield its increase, and the trees of the field shall yield their fruit. ⁵Your threshing shall continue until the vintage, and the vintage shall continue until the sowing time. You shall eat your bread to the full, and dwell in your land safely. ⁶"I will give peace in the land, and you shall lie down, and no one will make you afraid. I will remove evil animals out of the land, neither shall the sword go through your land. ⁷You shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword. ⁸Five of you shall chase a hundred, and a hundred of you shall chase ten thousand; and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword. ⁹"I will have respect for you, make you fruitful, multiply you, and will establish my covenant with you. ¹⁰You shall eat old supplies long kept, and you shall move out the old because of the new. ¹¹I will set my tent among you, and my soul won't abhor you. ¹²I will walk among you, and will be your God, and you will be my people. ¹³I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, that you should not be their slaves. I have broken the bars of your yoke, and made you walk upright. ¹⁴"But if you will not listen to me, and will not do all these commandments, ¹⁵and if you shall reject my statutes, and if your soul abhors my ordinances, so that you will not do all my commandments, but break my covenant, ¹⁶I also will do this to you: I will appoint terror over you, even consumption and fever, that shall consume the eyes, and make the soul to pine away. You will sow your seed in vain, for your enemies will eat it. ¹⁷I will set my face against you, and you will be struck before your enemies. Those who hate you will rule over you; and you will flee when no one pursues you. ¹⁸"If

you in spite of these things will not listen to me, then I will chastise you seven times more for your sins. ¹⁹I will break the pride of your power, and I will make your sky like iron, and your soil like bronze. ²⁰Your strength will be spent in vain; for your land won't yield its increase, neither will the trees of the land yield their fruit. ²¹"If you walk contrary to me, and won't listen to me, then I will bring seven times more plagues on you according to your sins. ²²I will send the wild animals among you, which will rob you of your children, destroy your livestock, and make you few in number. Your roads will become desolate. ²³"If by these things you won't be turned back to me, but will walk contrary to me, ²⁴then I will also walk contrary to you; and I will strike you, even I, seven times for your sins. ²⁵I will bring a sword upon you that will execute the vengeance of the covenant. You will be gathered together within your cities, and I will send the pestilence among you. You will be delivered into the hand of the enemy. ²⁶When I break your staff of bread, ten women shall bake your bread in one oven, and they shall deliver your bread again by weight. You shall eat, and not be satisfied. ²⁷"If you in spite of this won't listen to me, but walk contrary to me, ²⁸then I will walk contrary to you in wrath. I will also chastise you seven times for your sins. ²⁹You will eat the flesh of your sons, and you will eat the flesh of your daughters. ³⁰I will destroy your high places, and cut down your incense altars, and cast your dead bodies upon the bodies of your idols; and my soul will abhor you. ³¹I will lay your cities waste, and will bring your sanctuaries to desolation. I will not take delight in the sweet fragrance of your offerings. ³²I will bring the land into desolation, and your enemies who dwell in it will be astonished at it. ³³I will scatter you among the nations, and I will draw out the sword after you. Your land will be a desolation, and your cities shall be a waste. ³⁴Then the land will enjoy its Sabbaths as long as it lies desolate and you are in your enemies' land. Even then the land will rest and enjoy its Sabbaths. ³⁵As long as it lies desolate it shall have rest, even the rest which it didn't have in your Sabbaths when you lived on it. ³⁶"As for those of you who are left, I will send a faintness into their hearts in the lands of their enemies. The sound of a driven leaf will put them to flight; and they shall flee, as one flees from the sword. They will fall when no one pursues. ³⁷They will stumble over one another, as it were before the sword, when no one pursues. You will have no power to stand before your enemies. ³⁸You will perish among the nations. The land of your enemies will eat you up. ³⁹Those of you who are left will pine away in their iniquity in your enemies' lands; and also in the iniquities of their fathers they shall pine away with them. ⁴⁰"If they confess their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers, in their trespass which they trespassed against me; and also that because they walked contrary to me, ⁴¹I also walked contrary to them, and brought them into the land of their

enemies; if then their uncircumcised heart is humbled, and they then accept the punishment of their iniquity, ⁴²then I will remember my covenant with Jacob, my covenant with Isaac, and also my covenant with Abraham; and I will remember the land. ⁴³The land also will be left by them, and will enjoy its Sabbaths while it lies desolate without them; and they will accept the punishment of their iniquity because they rejected my ordinances, and their soul abhorred my statutes. ⁴⁴Yet for all that, when they are in the land of their enemies, I will not reject them, neither will I abhor them, to destroy them utterly and to break my covenant with them; for I am the LORD their God. ⁴⁵But I will for their sake remember the covenant of their ancestors, whom I brought out of the land of Egypt in the sight of the nations, that I might be their God. I am the LORD." ⁴⁶These are the statutes, ordinances, and laws, which the LORD made between him and the children of Israel in Mount Sinai by Moses.

27 The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Speak to the children of Israel, and say to them, 'When a man consecrates a person to the LORD in a vow, according to your valuation, ³your valuation of a male from twenty years old to sixty years old shall be fifty shekels of silver, according to the shekel ^{xxviii} of the sanctuary. ⁴If she is a female, then your valuation shall be thirty shekels. ⁵If the person is from five years old to twenty years old, then your valuation shall be for a male twenty shekels, and for a female ten shekels. ⁶If the person is from a month old to five years old, then your valuation shall be for a male five shekels of silver, and for a female your valuation shall be three shekels of silver. ⁷If the person is from sixty years old and upward; if he is a male, then your valuation shall be fifteen shekels, and for a female ten shekels. ⁸But if he is poorer than your valuation, then he shall be set before the priest, and the priest shall assign a value to him. The priest shall assign a value according to his ability to pay. ⁹"If it is an animal of which men offer an offering to the LORD, all that any man gives of such to the LORD becomes holy. ¹⁰He shall not alter it, nor exchange it, a good for a bad, or a bad for a good. If he shall at all exchange animal for animal, then both it and that for which it is exchanged shall be holy. ¹¹If it is any unclean animal, of which they do not offer as an offering to the LORD, then he shall set the animal before the priest; ¹²and the priest shall evaluate it, whether it is good or bad. As the priest evaluates it, so it shall be. ¹³But if he will indeed redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of it to its valuation. ¹⁴"When a man dedicates his house to be holy to the LORD, then the priest shall evaluate it, whether it is good or bad. As the priest evaluates it, so it shall stand. ¹⁵If he who dedicates it will redeem his house, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of your valuation to it, and it shall be his.

^{xxviii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

¹⁶“If a man dedicates to the LORD part of the field of his possession, then your valuation shall be according to the seed for it. The sowing of a homer ^{xxix} of barley shall be valued at fifty shekels ^{xxx} of silver. ¹⁷If he dedicates his field from the Year of Jubilee, according to your valuation it shall stand. ¹⁸But if he dedicates his field after the Jubilee, then the priest shall reckon to him the money according to the years that remain to the Year of Jubilee; and an abatement shall be made from your valuation. ¹⁹If he who dedicated the field will indeed redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of your valuation to it, and it shall remain his. ²⁰If he will not redeem the field, or if he has sold the field to another man, it shall not be redeemed any more; ²¹but the field, when it goes out in the Jubilee, shall be holy to the LORD, as a devoted field. It shall be owned by the priests. ²²“If he dedicates a field to the LORD which he has bought, which is not of the field of his possession, ²³then the priest shall reckon to him the worth of your valuation up to the Year of Jubilee; and he shall give your valuation on that day, as a holy thing to the LORD. ²⁴In the Year of Jubilee the field shall return to him from whom it was bought, even to him to whom the possession of the land belongs. ²⁵All your valuations shall be according to the shekel of the sanctuary: twenty gerahs ^{xxxi} to the shekel. ^{xxxii} ²⁶“However the firstborn among animals, which belongs to the LORD as a firstborn, no man may dedicate, whether an ox or a sheep. It is the LORD’s. ²⁷If it is an unclean animal, then he shall buy it back according to your valuation, and shall add to it the fifth part of it; or if it isn’t redeemed, then it shall be sold according to your valuation. ²⁸“Notwithstanding, no devoted thing that a man devotes to the LORD of all that he has, whether of man or animal, or of the field of his possession, shall be sold or redeemed. Everything that is permanently devoted is most holy to the LORD. ²⁹“No one devoted to destruction, who shall be devoted from among men, shall be ransomed. He shall surely be put to death. ³⁰“All the tithe of the land, whether of the seed of the land or of the fruit of the trees, is the LORD’s. It is holy to the LORD. ³¹If a man redeems anything of his tithe, he shall add a fifth part to it. ³²All the tithe of the herds or the flocks, whatever passes under the rod, the tenth shall be holy to the LORD. ³³He shall not examine whether it is good or bad, neither shall he exchange it. If he exchanges it at all, then both it and that for which it is exchanged shall be holy. It shall not be redeemed.” ³⁴These are the commandments which the LORD commanded Moses for the children of Israel on Mount Sinai.

^{xxix}1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

^{xxx}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xxxi}A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains.

^{xxxii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

Numbers

¹The LORD ⁱ spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the Tent of Meeting, on the first day of the second month, in the second year after they had come out of the land of Egypt, saying, ²“Take a census of all the congregation of the children of Israel, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, every male, one by one, ³from twenty years old and upward, all who are able to go out to war in Israel. You and Aaron shall count them by their divisions. ⁴With you there shall be a man of every tribe, each one head of his fathers’ house. ⁵These are the names of the men who shall stand with you: Of Reuben: Elizur the son of Shedeur. ⁶Of Simeon: Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai. ⁷Of Judah: Nahshon the son of Amminadab. ⁸Of Issachar: Nethanel the son of Zuar. ⁹Of Zebulun: Eliab the son of Helon. ¹⁰Of the children of Joseph: of Ephraim: Elishama the son of Amihud; of Manasseh: Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur. ¹¹Of Benjamin: Abidan the son of Gideon. ¹²Of Dan: Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai. ¹³Of Asher: Pagiel the son of Ochran. ¹⁴Of Gad: Eliasaph the son of Deuel. ¹⁵Of Naphtali: Ahira the son of Enan.” ¹⁶These are those who were called of the congregation, the princes ⁱⁱ of the tribes of their fathers; they were the heads of the thousands of Israel. ¹⁷Moses and Aaron took these men who are mentioned by name. ¹⁸They assembled all the congregation together on the first day of the second month; and they declared their ancestry by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, one by one. ¹⁹As the LORD commanded Moses, so he counted them in the wilderness of Sinai. ²⁰The children of Reuben, Israel’s firstborn, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, one by one, every male from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ²¹those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Reuben, were forty-six thousand five hundred. ²²Of the children of Simeon, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, those who were counted of it, according to the number of the names, one by one, ev-

ery male from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ²³those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Simeon, were fifty-nine thousand three hundred. ²⁴Of the children of Gad, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ²⁵those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Gad, were forty-five thousand six hundred fifty. ²⁶Of the children of Judah, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ²⁷those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Judah, were seventy-four thousand six hundred. ²⁸Of the children of Issachar, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ²⁹those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Issachar, were fifty-four thousand four hundred. ³⁰Of the children of Zebulun, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ³¹those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Zebulun, were fifty-seven thousand four hundred. ³²Of the children of Joseph: of the children of Ephraim, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ³³those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Ephraim, were forty thousand five hundred. ³⁴Of the children of Manasseh, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ³⁵those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Manasseh, were thirty-two thousand two hundred. ³⁶Of the children of Benjamin, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ³⁷those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Benjamin, were thirty-five thousand four hundred. ³⁸Of the children of Dan, their generations, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱor, chiefs, or, leaders

able to go out to war: ³⁹those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Dan, were sixty-two thousand seven hundred. ⁴⁰Of the children of Asher, their generations, by their families, by their fathers' houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ⁴¹those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Asher, were forty-one thousand five hundred. ⁴²Of the children of Naphtali, their generations, by their families, by their fathers' houses, according to the number of the names, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war: ⁴³those who were counted of them, of the tribe of Naphtali, were fifty-three thousand four hundred. ⁴⁴These are those who were counted, whom Moses and Aaron counted, and the twelve men who were princes of Israel, each one for his fathers' house. ⁴⁵So all those who were counted of the children of Israel by their fathers' houses, from twenty years old and upward, all who were able to go out to war in Israel—⁴⁶all those who were counted were six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty. ⁴⁷But the Levites after the tribe of their fathers were not counted among them. ⁴⁸For the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁴⁹"Only the tribe of Levi you shall not count, neither shall you take a census of them among the children of Israel; ⁵⁰but appoint the Levites over the Tabernacle of the Testimony, and over all its furnishings, and over all that belongs to it. They shall carry the tabernacle and all its furnishings; and they shall take care of it, and shall encamp around it. ⁵¹When the tabernacle is to move, the Levites shall take it down; and when the tabernacle is to be set up, the Levites shall set it up. The stranger who comes near shall be put to death. ⁵²The children of Israel shall pitch their tents, every man by his own camp, and every man by his own standard, according to their divisions. ⁵³But the Levites shall encamp around the Tabernacle of the Testimony, that there may be no wrath on the congregation of the children of Israel. The Levites shall be responsible for the Tabernacle of the Testimony." ⁵⁴Thus the children of Israel did. According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so they did.

²The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²"The children of Israel shall encamp every man by his own standard, with the banners of their fathers' houses. They shall encamp around the Tent of Meeting at a distance from it." ³Those who encamp on the east side toward the sunrise shall be of the standard of the camp of Judah, according to their divisions. The prince of the children of Judah shall be Nahshon the son of Amminadab. ⁴His division, and those who were counted of them, were seventy-four thousand six hundred. ⁵Those who encamp next to him shall be the tribe of Issachar. The prince of the children of Issachar shall be Nethanel the son of Zuar. ⁶His division, and those who were counted of it, were fifty-four thousand four hundred. ⁷The tribe of Zebulun: the prince

of the children of Zebulun shall be Eliab the son of Helon. ⁸His division, and those who were counted of it, were fifty-seven thousand four hundred. ⁹All who were counted of the camp of Judah were one hundred eighty-six thousand four hundred, according to their divisions. They shall set out first. ¹⁰"On the south side shall be the standard of the camp of Reuben according to their divisions. The prince of the children of Reuben shall be Elizur the son of Shedeur. ¹¹His division, and those who were counted of it, were forty-six thousand five hundred. ¹²"Those who encamp next to him shall be the tribe of Simeon. The prince of the children of Simeon shall be Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai. ¹³His division, and those who were counted of them, were fifty-nine thousand three hundred. ¹⁴"The tribe of Gad: the prince of the children of Gad shall be Eliasaph the son of Reuel. ¹⁵His division, and those who were counted of them, were forty-five thousand six hundred fifty. ¹⁶"All who were counted of the camp of Reuben were one hundred fifty-one thousand four hundred fifty, according to their armies. They shall set out second. ¹⁷"Then the Tent of Meeting shall set out, with the camp of the Levites in the middle of the camps. As they encamp, so shall they set out, every man in his place, by their standards. ¹⁸"On the west side shall be the standard of the camp of Ephraim according to their divisions. The prince of the children of Ephraim shall be Elishama the son of Ammihud. ¹⁹His division, and those who were counted of them, were forty thousand five hundred. ²⁰"Next to him shall be the tribe of Manasseh. The prince of the children of Manasseh shall be Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur. ²¹His division, and those who were counted of them, were thirty-two thousand two hundred. ²²"The tribe of Benjamin: the prince of the children of Benjamin shall be Abidan the son of Gideon. ²³His army, and those who were counted of them, were thirty-five thousand four hundred. ²⁴"All who were counted of the camp of Ephraim were one hundred eight thousand one hundred, according to their divisions. They shall set out third. ²⁵"On the north side shall be the standard of the camp of Dan according to their divisions. The prince of the children of Dan shall be Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai. ²⁶His division, and those who were counted of them, were sixty-two thousand seven hundred. ²⁷"Those who encamp next to him shall be the tribe of Asher. The prince of the children of Asher shall be Pagiel the son of Ochran. ²⁸His division, and those who were counted of them, were forty-one thousand five hundred. ²⁹"The tribe of Naphtali: the prince of the children of Naphtali shall be Ahira the son of Enan. ³⁰His division, and those who were counted of them, were fifty-three thousand four hundred. ³¹"All who were counted of the camp of Dan were one hundred fifty-seven thousand six hundred. They shall set out last by their standards." ³²These are those who were counted of the children of Israel by their fathers' houses. All who were counted of the camps accord-

ing to their armies were six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty. ³³But the Levites were not counted among the children of Israel, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³⁴Thus the children of Israel did. According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so they encamped by their standards, and so they set out, everyone by their families, according to their fathers' houses.

3Now this is the history of the generations of Aaron and Moses in the day that the LORD spoke with Moses in Mount Sinai. ²These are the names of the sons of Aaron: Nadab the firstborn, and Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. ³These are the names of the sons of Aaron, the priests who were anointed, whom he consecrated to minister in the priest's office. ⁴Nadab and Abihu died before the LORD when they offered strange fire before the LORD in the wilderness of Sinai, and they had no children. Eleazar and Ithamar ministered in the priest's office in the presence of Aaron their father. ⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁶"Bring the tribe of Levi near, and set them before Aaron the priest, that they may minister to him. ⁷They shall keep his requirements, and the requirements of the whole congregation before the Tent of Meeting, to do the service of the tabernacle. ⁸They shall keep all the furnishings of the Tent of Meeting, and the obligations of the children of Israel, to do the service of the tabernacle. ⁹You shall give the Levites to Aaron and to his sons. They are wholly given to him on the behalf of the children of Israel. ¹⁰You shall appoint Aaron and his sons, and they shall keep their priesthood, but the stranger who comes near shall be put to death." ¹¹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹²"Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I have taken the Levites from among the children of Israel instead of all the firstborn who open the womb among the children of Israel; and the Levites shall be mine, ¹³for all the firstborn are mine. On the day that I struck down all the firstborn in the land of Egypt I made holy to me all the firstborn in Israel, both man and animal. They shall be mine. I am the LORD." ¹⁴The LORD spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, saying, ¹⁵"Count the children of Levi by their fathers' houses, by their families. You shall count every male from a month old and upward." ¹⁶Moses counted them according to the LORD's word, as he was commanded. ¹⁷These were the sons of Levi by their names: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. ¹⁸These are the names of the sons of Gershon by their families: Libni and Shimei. ¹⁹The sons of Kohath by their families: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. ²⁰The sons of Merari by their families: Mahli and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to their fathers' houses. ²¹Of Gershon was the family of the Libnites, and the family of the Shimeites. These are the families of the Gershonites. ²²Those who were counted of them, accord-

ing to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, even those who were counted of them were seven thousand five hundred. ²³The families of the Gershonites shall encamp behind the tabernacle westward. ²⁴Eliasaph the son of Lael shall be the prince of the fathers' house of the Gershonites. ²⁵The duty of the sons of Gershon in the Tent of Meeting shall be the tabernacle, the tent, its covering, the screen for the door of the Tent of Meeting, ²⁶the hangings of the court, the screen for the door of the court which is by the tabernacle and around the altar, and its cords for all of its service. ²⁷Of Kohath was the family of the Amramites, the family of the Izharites, the family of the Hebronites, and the family of the Uzzielites. These are the families of the Kohathites. ²⁸According to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, there were eight thousand six hundred keeping the requirements of the sanctuary. ²⁹The families of the sons of Kohath shall encamp on the south side of the tabernacle. ³⁰The prince of the fathers' house of the families of the Kohathites shall be Elizaphan the son of Uzziel. ³¹Their duty shall be the ark, the table, the lamp stand, the altars, the vessels of the sanctuary with which they minister, the screen, and all its service. ³²Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall be prince of the princes of the Levites, with the oversight of those who keep the requirements of the sanctuary. ³³Of Merari was the family of the Mahlites and the family of the Mushites. These are the families of Merari. ³⁴Those who were counted of them, according to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, were six thousand two hundred. ^{iv} ³⁵The prince of the fathers' house of the families of Merari was Zuriel the son of Abihail. They shall encamp on the north side of the tabernacle. ³⁶The appointed duty of the sons of Merari shall be the tabernacle's boards, its bars, its pillars, its sockets, all its instruments, all its service, ³⁷the pillars of the court around it, their sockets, their pins, and their cords. ³⁸Those who encamp before the tabernacle eastward, in front of the Tent of Meeting toward the sunrise, shall be Moses, with Aaron and his sons, keeping the requirements of the sanctuary for the duty of the children of Israel. The outsider who comes near shall be put to death. ³⁹All who were counted of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron counted at the commandment of the LORD, by their families, all the males from a month old and upward, were twenty-two thousand. ⁴⁰The LORD said to Moses, "Count all the firstborn males of the children of Israel from a month old and upward, and take the number of their names. ⁴¹You shall take the Levites for me—I am the LORD—instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel; and the livestock of the Levites instead of all the firstborn among

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}+ 22,000 is the sum rounded to 2 significant digits. The sum of the Gershonites, Kohathites, and Merarites given above is 22,300, but the traditional Hebrew text has the number rounded to 2 significant digits, not 3 significant digits.

the livestock of the children of Israel.” ⁴²Moses counted, as the LORD commanded him, all the firstborn among the children of Israel. ⁴³All the firstborn males according to the number of names from a month old and upward, of those who were counted of them, were twenty-two thousand two hundred seventy-three. ⁴⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁴⁵“Take the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the livestock of the Levites instead of their livestock; and the Levites shall be mine. I am the LORD. ⁴⁶For the redemption of the two hundred seventy-three of the firstborn of the children of Israel who exceed the number of the Levites, ⁴⁷you shall take five shekels apiece for each one; according to the shekel ^v of the sanctuary you shall take them (the shekel is twenty gerahs ^{vi}); ⁴⁸and you shall give the money, with which their remainder is redeemed, to Aaron and to his sons.” ⁴⁹Moses took the redemption money from those who exceeded the number of those who were redeemed by the Levites; ⁵⁰from the firstborn of the children of Israel he took the money, one thousand three hundred sixty-five shekels, ^{vii} according to the shekel of the sanctuary; ⁵¹and Moses gave the redemption money to Aaron and to his sons, according to the LORD’s word, as the LORD commanded Moses.

⁴The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²“Take a census of the sons of Kohath from among the sons of Levi, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, ³from thirty years old and upward even until fifty years old, all who enter into the service to do the work in the Tent of Meeting. ⁴“This is the service of the sons of Kohath in the Tent of Meeting, regarding the most holy things. ⁵When the camp moves forward, Aaron shall go in with his sons; and they shall take down the veil of the screen, cover the ark of the Testimony with it, ⁶put a covering of sealskin on it, spread a blue cloth over it, and put in its poles. ⁷“On the table of show bread they shall spread a blue cloth, and put on it the dishes, the spoons, the bowls, and the cups with which to pour out; and the continual bread shall be on it. ⁸They shall spread on them a scarlet cloth, and cover it with a covering of sealskin, and shall put in its poles. ⁹“They shall take a blue cloth and cover the lamp stand of the light, its lamps, its snuffers, its snuff dishes, and all its oil vessels, with which they minister to it. ¹⁰They shall put it and all its vessels within a covering of sealskin, and shall put it on the frame. ¹¹“On the golden altar they shall spread a blue cloth, and cover it with a covering of sealskin, and shall put in its poles. ¹²“They shall take all the vessels of ministry with which they minister in the sanctuary, and put them in a blue cloth, cover them with a covering of sealskin, and shall put them on the frame. ¹³“They shall

take away the ashes from the altar, and spread a purple cloth on it. ¹⁴They shall put on it all its vessels with which they minister about it, the fire pans, the meat hooks, the shovels, and the basins—all the vessels of the altar; and they shall spread on it a covering of sealskin, and put in its poles. ¹⁵“When Aaron and his sons have finished covering the sanctuary and all the furniture of the sanctuary, as the camp moves forward; after that, the sons of Kohath shall come to carry it; but they shall not touch the sanctuary, lest they die. The sons of Kohath shall carry these things belonging to the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁶“The duty of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall be the oil for the light, the sweet incense, the continual meal offering, and the anointing oil, the requirements of all the tabernacle, and of all that is in it, the sanctuary, and its furnishings.” ¹⁷The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ¹⁸“Don’t cut off the tribe of the families of the Kohathites from among the Levites; ¹⁹but do this to them, that they may live, and not die, when they approach the most holy things: Aaron and his sons shall go in and appoint everyone to his service and to his burden; ²⁰but they shall not go in to see the sanctuary even for a moment, lest they die.” ²¹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²²“Take a census of the sons of Gershon also, by their fathers’ houses, by their families; ²³you shall count them from thirty years old and upward until fifty years old: all who enter in to wait on the service, to do the work in the Tent of Meeting. ²⁴“This is the service of the families of the Gershonites, in serving and in bearing burdens: ²⁵they shall carry the curtains of the tabernacle and the Tent of Meeting, its covering, the covering of sealskin that is on it, the screen for the door of the Tent of Meeting, ²⁶the hangings of the court, the screen for the door of the gate of the court which is by the tabernacle and around the altar, their cords, and all the instruments of their service, and whatever shall be done with them. They shall serve in there. ²⁷At the commandment of Aaron and his sons shall be all the service of the sons of the Gershonites, in all their burden and in all their service; and you shall appoint their duty to them in all their responsibilities. ²⁸This is the service of the families of the sons of the Gershonites in the Tent of Meeting. Their duty shall be under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest. ²⁹“As for the sons of Merari, you shall count them by their families, by their fathers’ houses; ³⁰you shall count them from thirty years old and upward even to fifty years old—everyone who enters on the service, to do the work of the Tent of Meeting. ³¹This is the duty of their burden, according to all their service in the Tent of Meeting: the tabernacle’s boards, its bars, its pillars, its sockets, ³²the pillars of the court around it, their sockets, their pins, their cords, with all their instruments, and with all their service. You shall appoint the instruments of the duty of their burden to them by name. ³³This is the service of the families of the sons of Merari, according to all their service in the

^vA shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{vi}A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains.

^{vii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1365 shekels is about 13.65 kilograms or about 30 pounds.

Tent of Meeting, under the hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.” ³⁴Moses and Aaron and the princes of the congregation counted the sons of the Kohathites by their families, and by their fathers’ houses, ³⁵from thirty years old and upward even to fifty years old, everyone who entered into the service for work in the Tent of Meeting. ³⁶Those who were counted of them by their families were two thousand seven hundred fifty. ³⁷These are those who were counted of the families of the Kohathites, all who served in the Tent of Meeting, whom Moses and Aaron counted according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses. ³⁸Those who were counted of the sons of Gershon, by their families, and by their fathers’ houses, ³⁹from thirty years old and upward even to fifty years old—everyone who entered into the service for work in the Tent of Meeting, ⁴⁰even those who were counted of them, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, were two thousand six hundred thirty. ⁴¹These are those who were counted of the families of the sons of Gershon, all who served in the Tent of Meeting, whom Moses and Aaron counted according to the commandment of the LORD. ⁴²Those who were counted of the families of the sons of Merari, by their families, by their fathers’ houses, ⁴³from thirty years old and upward even to fifty years old—everyone who entered into the service for work in the Tent of Meeting, ⁴⁴even those who were counted of them by their families, were three thousand two hundred. ⁴⁵These are those who were counted of the families of the sons of Merari, whom Moses and Aaron counted according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses. ⁴⁶All those who were counted of the Levites whom Moses and Aaron and the princes of Israel counted, by their families and by their fathers’ houses, ⁴⁷from thirty years old and upward even to fifty years old, everyone who entered in to do the work of service and the work of bearing burdens in the Tent of Meeting, ⁴⁸even those who were counted of them, were eight thousand five hundred eighty. ⁴⁹According to the commandment of the LORD they were counted by Moses, everyone according to his service and according to his burden. Thus they were counted by him, as the LORD commanded Moses.

⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Command the children of Israel that they put out of the camp every leper, everyone who has a discharge, and whoever is unclean by a corpse. ³You shall put both male and female outside of the camp so that they don’t defile their camp, in the midst of which I dwell.” ⁴The children of Israel did so, and put them outside of the camp; as the LORD spoke to Moses, so the children of Israel did. ⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁶“Speak to the children of Israel: ‘When a man or woman commits any sin that men commit, so as to trespass against the LORD, and that soul is guilty, ⁷then he shall confess his sin which he has done; and he shall make restitution for his guilt in full, add to it the

fifth part of it, and give it to him in respect of whom he has been guilty. ⁸But if the man has no kinsman to whom restitution may be made for the guilt, the restitution for guilt which is made to the LORD shall be the priest’s, in addition to the ram of the atonement, by which atonement shall be made for him. ⁹Every heave offering of all the holy things of the children of Israel, which they present to the priest, shall be his. ¹⁰Every man’s holy things shall be his; whatever any man gives the priest, it shall be his.’” ¹¹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them: ‘If any man’s wife goes astray and is unfaithful to him, ¹³and a man lies with her carnally, and it is hidden from the eyes of her husband and this is kept concealed, and she is defiled, there is no witness against her, and she isn’t taken in the act; ¹⁴and the spirit of jealousy comes on him, and he is jealous of his wife and she is defiled; or if the spirit of jealousy comes on him, and he is jealous of his wife and she isn’t defiled; ¹⁵then the man shall bring his wife to the priest, and shall bring her offering for her: one tenth of an ephah ^{viii} of barley meal. He shall pour no oil on it, nor put frankincense on it, for it is a meal offering of jealousy, a meal offering of memorial, bringing iniquity to memory. ¹⁶The priest shall bring her near, and set her before the LORD. ¹⁷The priest shall take holy water in an earthen vessel; and the priest shall take some of the dust that is on the floor of the tabernacle and put it into the water. ¹⁸The priest shall set the woman before the LORD, and let the hair of the woman’s head go loose, and put the meal offering of memorial in her hands, which is the meal offering of jealousy. The priest shall have in his hand the water of bitterness that brings a curse. ¹⁹The priest shall cause her to take an oath and shall tell the woman, ‘If no man has lain with you, and if you haven’t gone aside to uncleanness, being under your husband’s authority, be free from this water of bitterness that brings a curse. ²⁰But if you have gone astray, being under your husband’s authority, and if you are defiled, and some man has lain with you besides your husband—’ ²¹then the priest shall cause the woman to swear with the oath of cursing, and the priest shall tell the woman, ‘May The LORD make you a curse and an oath among your people, when the LORD allows your thigh to fall away, and your body to swell; ²²and this water that brings a curse will go into your bowels, and make your body swell, and your thigh fall away.’ The woman shall say, ‘Amen, Amen.’” ²³“The priest shall write these curses in a book, and he shall wipe them into the water of bitterness. ²⁴He shall make the woman drink the water of bitterness that causes the curse; and the water that causes the curse shall enter into her and become bitter. ²⁵The priest shall take the meal offering of jealousy out of the woman’s hand, and shall wave the meal offering before the LORD, and bring it to the altar. ²⁶The priest shall take a handful of

^{viii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

the meal offering, as its memorial portion, and burn it on the altar, and afterward shall make the woman drink the water. ²⁷When he has made her drink the water, then it shall happen, if she is defiled and has committed a trespass against her husband, that the water that causes the curse will enter into her and become bitter, and her body will swell, and her thigh will fall away; and the woman will be a curse among her people. ²⁸If the woman isn't defiled, but is clean; then she shall be free, and shall conceive offspring. ^{ix} ²⁹“This is the law of jealousy, when a wife, being under her husband, goes astray, and is defiled, ³⁰or when the spirit of jealousy comes on a man, and he is jealous of his wife; then he shall set the woman before the LORD, and the priest shall execute on her all this law. ³¹The man shall be free from iniquity, and that woman shall bear her iniquity.”

⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them: ‘When either man or woman shall make a special vow, the vow of a Nazirite, to separate himself to the LORD, ³he shall separate himself from wine and strong drink. He shall drink no vinegar of wine, or vinegar of fermented drink, neither shall he drink any juice of grapes, nor eat fresh grapes or dried. ⁴All the days of his separation he shall eat nothing that is made of the grapevine, from the seeds even to the skins. ⁵“All the days of his vow of separation no razor shall come on his head, until the days are fulfilled in which he separates himself to the LORD. He shall be holy. He shall let the locks of the hair of his head grow long. ⁶“All the days that he separates himself to the LORD he shall not go near a dead body. ⁷He shall not make himself unclean for his father, or for his mother, for his brother, or for his sister, when they die, because his separation to God ^x is on his head. ⁸All the days of his separation he is holy to the LORD. ⁹“If any man dies very suddenly beside him, and he defiles the head of his separation, then he shall shave his head in the day of his cleansing. On the seventh day he shall shave it. ¹⁰On the eighth day he shall bring two turtledoves or two young pigeons to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting. ¹¹The priest shall offer one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, and make atonement for him, because he sinned by reason of the dead, and shall make his head holy that same day. ¹²He shall separate to the LORD the days of his separation, and shall bring a male lamb a year old for a trespass offering; but the former days shall be void, because his separation was defiled. ¹³“This is the law of the Nazirite: when the days of his separation are fulfilled, he shall be brought to the door of the Tent of Meeting, ¹⁴and he shall offer his offering to the LORD: one male lamb a year old without defect for a burnt offering, one ewe lamb a year old without

defect for a sin offering, one ram without defect for peace offerings, ¹⁵a basket of unleavened bread, cakes of fine flour mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed with oil with their meal offering and their drink offerings. ¹⁶The priest shall present them before the LORD, and shall offer his sin offering and his burnt offering. ¹⁷He shall offer the ram for a sacrifice of peace offerings to the LORD, with the basket of unleavened bread. The priest shall offer also its meal offering and its drink offering. ¹⁸The Nazirite shall shave the head of his separation at the door of the Tent of Meeting, take the hair of the head of his separation, and put it on the fire which is under the sacrifice of peace offerings. ¹⁹The priest shall take the boiled shoulder of the ram, one unleavened cake out of the basket, and one unleavened wafer, and shall put them on the hands of the Nazirite after he has shaved the head of his separation; ²⁰and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. They are holy for the priest, together with the breast that is waved and the thigh that is offered. After that the Nazirite may drink wine. ²¹“This is the law of the Nazirite who vows and of his offering to the LORD for his separation, in addition to that which he is able to afford. According to his vow which he vows, so he must do after the law of his separation.” ²²The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²³“Speak to Aaron and to his sons, saying, ‘This is how you shall bless the children of Israel.’ You shall tell them, ²⁴‘The LORD bless you, and keep you. ²⁵The LORD make his face to shine on you, and be gracious to you. ²⁶The LORD lift up his face toward you, and give you peace.’ ²⁷“So they shall put my name on the children of Israel; and I will bless them.”

⁷On the day that Moses had finished setting up the tabernacle, and had anointed it and sanctified it with all its furniture, and the altar with all its vessels, and had anointed and sanctified them; ²the princes of Israel, the heads of their fathers' houses, gave offerings. These were the princes of the tribes. These are they who were over those who were counted; ³and they brought their offering before the LORD, six covered wagons and twelve oxen; a wagon for every two of the princes, and for each one an ox. They presented them before the tabernacle. ⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁵“Accept these from them, that they may be used in doing the service of the Tent of Meeting; and you shall give them to the Levites, to every man according to his service.” ⁶Moses took the wagons and the oxen, and gave them to the Levites. ⁷He gave two wagons and four oxen to the sons of Gershon, according to their service. ⁸He gave four wagons and eight oxen to the sons of Merari, according to their service, under the direction of Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest. ⁹But to the sons of Kohath he gave none, because the service of the sanctuary belonged to them; they carried it on their shoulders. ¹⁰The princes gave offerings for the dedication of the altar

^{ix}or, seed

^xThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is “ (Elohim).

in the day that it was anointed. The princes gave their offerings before the altar. ¹¹The LORD said to Moses, "They shall offer their offering, each prince on his day, for the dedication of the altar." ¹²He who offered his offering the first day was Nahshon the son of Amminadab, of the tribe of Judah, ¹³and his offering was: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, ^{xi} one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ¹⁴one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ¹⁵one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ¹⁶one male goat for a sin offering; ¹⁷and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Nahshon the son of Amminadab. ¹⁸On the second day Nethanel the son of Zuar, prince of Issachar, gave his offering. ¹⁹He offered for his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ²⁰one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ²¹one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ²²one male goat for a sin offering; ²³and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Nethanel the son of Zuar. ²⁴On the third day Eliab the son of Helon, prince of the children of Zebulun, ²⁵gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was a hundred and thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ²⁶one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ²⁷one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ²⁸one male goat for a sin offering; ²⁹and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Eliab the son of Helon. ³⁰On the fourth day Elizur the son of Shedeur, prince of the children of Reuben, ³¹gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ³²one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ³³one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ³⁴one male goat for a sin offering; ³⁵and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Elizur the son of Shedeur. ³⁶On the fifth day Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai, prince of the children of Simeon, ³⁷gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full

of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ³⁸one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ³⁹one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁴⁰one male goat for a sin offering; ⁴¹and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old: this was the offering of Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai. ⁴²On the sixth day, Eliasaph the son of Deuel, prince of the children of Gad, ⁴³gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁴⁴one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁴⁵one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁴⁶one male goat for a sin offering; ⁴⁷and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Eliasaph the son of Deuel. ⁴⁸On the seventh day Elishama the son of Ammihud, prince of the children of Ephraim, ⁴⁹gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁵⁰one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁵¹one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁵²one male goat for a sin offering; ⁵³and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Elishama the son of Ammihud. ⁵⁴On the eighth day Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur, prince of the children of Manasseh, ⁵⁵gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁵⁶one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁵⁷one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁵⁸one male goat for a sin offering; ⁵⁹and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur. ⁶⁰On the ninth day Abidan the son of Gideoni, prince of the children of Benjamin, ⁶¹gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁶²one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁶³one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁶⁴one male goat for a sin offering; ⁶⁵and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Abidan the son of Gideoni. ⁶⁶On the tenth day Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai, prince of the children of Dan, ⁶⁷gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one

^{xi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁶⁸one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁶⁹one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁷⁰one male goat for a sin offering; ⁷¹and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai. ⁷²On the eleventh day Pagiel the son of Ochran, prince of the children of Asher, ⁷³gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁷⁴one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁷⁵one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁷⁶one male goat for a sin offering; ⁷⁷and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Pagiel the son of Ochran. ⁷⁸On the twelfth day Ahira the son of Enan, prince of the children of Naphtali, ⁷⁹gave his offering: one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels, one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering; ⁸⁰one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense; ⁸¹one young bull, one ram, one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering; ⁸²one male goat for a sin offering; ⁸³and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Ahira the son of Enan. ⁸⁴This was the dedication offering of the altar, on the day when it was anointed, by the princes of Israel: twelve silver platters, twelve silver bowls, twelve golden ladles; ⁸⁵each silver platter weighing one hundred thirty shekels, and each bowl seventy; all the silver of the vessels two thousand four hundred shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary; ⁸⁶the twelve golden ladles, full of incense, weighing ten shekels apiece, according to the shekel of the sanctuary; all the gold of the ladles weighed one hundred twenty shekels; ⁸⁷all the cattle for the burnt offering twelve bulls, the rams twelve, the male lambs a year old twelve, and their meal offering; and twelve male goats for a sin offering; ⁸⁸and all the cattle for the sacrifice of peace offerings: twenty-four bulls, sixty rams, sixty male goats, and sixty male lambs a year old. This was the dedication offering of the altar, after it was anointed. ⁸⁹When Moses went into the Tent of Meeting to speak with the LORD, he heard his voice speaking to him from above the mercy seat that was on the ark of the Testimony, from between the two cherubim; and he spoke to him.

⁸The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to Aaron, and tell him, ‘When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the lamp stand.’” ³Aaron did so.

He lit its lamps to light the area in front of the lamp stand, as the LORD commanded Moses. ⁴This was the workmanship of the lamp stand, beaten work of gold. From its base to its flowers, it was beaten work. He made the lamp stand according to the pattern which the LORD had shown Moses. ⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁶“Take the Levites from among the children of Israel, and cleanse them. ⁷You shall do this to them to cleanse them: sprinkle the water of cleansing on them, let them shave their whole bodies with a razor, let them wash their clothes, and cleanse themselves. ⁸Then let them take a young bull and its meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil; and another young bull you shall take for a sin offering. ⁹You shall present the Levites before the Tent of Meeting. You shall assemble the whole congregation of the children of Israel. ¹⁰You shall present the Levites before the LORD. The children of Israel shall lay their hands on the Levites, ¹¹and Aaron shall offer the Levites before the LORD for a wave offering on the behalf of the children of Israel, that it may be theirs to do the service of the LORD. ¹²“The Levites shall lay their hands on the heads of the bulls, and you shall offer the one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering to the LORD, to make atonement for the Levites. ¹³You shall set the Levites before Aaron and before his sons, and offer them as a wave offering to the LORD. ¹⁴Thus you shall separate the Levites from among the children of Israel, and the Levites shall be mine. ¹⁵“After that, the Levites shall go in to do the service of the Tent of Meeting. You shall cleanse them, and offer them as a wave offering. ¹⁶For they are wholly given to me from among the children of Israel; instead of all who open the womb, even the firstborn of all the children of Israel, I have taken them to me. ¹⁷For all the firstborn among the children of Israel are mine, both man and animal. On the day that I struck all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, I sanctified them for myself. ¹⁸I have taken the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel. ¹⁹I have given the Levites as a gift to Aaron and to his sons from among the children of Israel, to do the service of the children of Israel in the Tent of Meeting, and to make atonement for the children of Israel, so that there will be no plague among the children of Israel when the children of Israel come near to the sanctuary.” ²⁰Moses, and Aaron, and all the congregation of the children of Israel did so to the Levites. According to all that the LORD commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so the children of Israel did to them. ²¹The Levites purified themselves from sin, and they washed their clothes; and Aaron offered them for a wave offering before the LORD and Aaron made atonement for them to cleanse them. ²²After that, the Levites went in to do their service in the Tent of Meeting before Aaron and before his sons: as the LORD had commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so they did to them. ²³The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁴“This is what is assigned

to the Levites: from twenty-five years old and upward they shall go in to wait on the service in the work of the Tent of Meeting;²⁵ and from the age of fifty years they shall retire from doing the work, and shall serve no more,²⁶ but shall assist their brothers in the Tent of Meeting, to perform the duty, and shall perform no service. This is how you shall have the Levites do their duties.”

9The LORD spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the first month of the second year after they had come out of the land of Egypt, saying,² “Let the children of Israel keep the Passover in its appointed season.³ On the fourteenth day of this month, at evening, you shall keep it in its appointed season. You shall keep it according to all its statutes and according to all its ordinances.”⁴ Moses told the children of Israel that they should keep the Passover.⁵ They kept the Passover in the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at evening, in the wilderness of Sinai. According to all that the LORD commanded Moses, so the children of Israel did.⁶ There were certain men who were unclean because of the dead body of a man, so that they could not keep the Passover on that day, and they came before Moses and Aaron on that day.⁷ Those men said to him, “We are unclean because of the dead body of a man. Why are we kept back, that we may not offer the offering of the LORD in its appointed season among the children of Israel?”⁸ Moses answered them, “Wait, that I may hear what the LORD will command concerning you.”⁹ The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,¹⁰ “Say to the children of Israel, ‘If any man of you or of your generations is unclean by reason of a dead body, or is on a journey far away, he shall still keep the Passover to the LORD.’¹¹ In the second month, on the fourteenth day at evening they shall keep it; they shall eat it with unleavened bread and bitter herbs.¹² They shall leave none of it until the morning, nor break a bone of it. According to all the statute of the Passover they shall keep it.¹³ But the man who is clean, and is not on a journey, and fails to keep the Passover, that soul shall be cut off from his people. Because he didn’t offer the offering of the LORD in its appointed season, that man shall bear his sin.¹⁴ “If a foreigner lives among you and desires to keep the Passover to the LORD, then he shall do so according to the statute of the Passover, and according to its ordinance. You shall have one statute, both for the foreigner and for him who is born in the land.”¹⁵ On the day that the tabernacle was raised up, the cloud covered the tabernacle, even the Tent of the Testimony. At evening it was over the tabernacle, as it were the appearance of fire, until morning.¹⁶ So it was continually. The cloud covered it, and the appearance of fire by night.¹⁷ Whenever the cloud was taken up from over the Tent, then after that the children of Israel traveled; and in the place where the cloud remained, there the children of Israel encamped.¹⁸ At the commandment of the LORD, the children of Is-

rael traveled, and at the commandment of the LORD they encamped. As long as the cloud remained on the tabernacle they remained encamped.¹⁹ When the cloud stayed on the tabernacle many days, then the children of Israel kept the LORD’s command, and didn’t travel.²⁰ Sometimes the cloud was a few days on the tabernacle; then according to the commandment of the LORD they remained encamped, and according to the commandment of the LORD they traveled.²¹ Sometimes the cloud was from evening until morning; and when the cloud was taken up in the morning, they traveled; or by day and by night, when the cloud was taken up, they traveled.²² Whether it was two days, or a month, or a year that the cloud stayed on the tabernacle, remaining on it, the children of Israel remained encamped, and didn’t travel; but when it was taken up, they traveled.²³ At the commandment of the LORD they encamped, and at the commandment of the LORD they traveled. They kept the LORD’s command, at the commandment of the LORD by Moses.

10The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,² “Make two shofars^{xii} or, trumpets of silver. You shall make them of beaten work. You shall use them for the calling of the congregation and for the journeying of the camps.³ When they blow them, all the congregation shall gather themselves to you at the door of the Tent of Meeting.⁴ If they blow just one, then the princes, the heads of the thousands of Israel, shall gather themselves to you.⁵ When you blow an alarm, the camps that lie on the east side shall go forward.⁶ When you blow an alarm the second time, the camps that lie on the south side shall go forward. They shall blow an alarm for their journeys.⁷ But when the assembly is to be gathered together, you shall blow, but you shall not sound an alarm.⁸ “The sons of Aaron, the priests, shall blow the shofars^{xiii} or, trumpets. This shall be to you for a statute forever throughout your generations.⁹ When you go to war in your land against the adversary who oppresses you, then you shall sound an alarm with the shofars^{xiv} or, trumpets. Then you will be remembered before the LORD your God, and you will be saved from your enemies.¹⁰ “Also in the day of your gladness, and in your set feasts, and in the beginnings of your months, you shall blow the shofars^{xv} or, trumpet over your burnt offerings, and over the sacrifices of your peace offerings; and they shall be to you for a memorial before your God. I am the LORD your God.”¹¹ In the second year, in the second month, on the twentieth day of the month, the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle of the covenant.¹² The children of Israel went forward on their journeys out of the wilderness of Sinai; and the cloud stayed in the wilderness of Paran.

^{xii} or, trumpets

^{xiii} or, trumpets.

^{xiv} or, trumpets.

^{xv} or, trumpets

¹³They first went forward according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses. ¹⁴First, the standard of the camp of the children of Judah went forward according to their armies. Nahshon the son of Amminadab was over his army. ¹⁵Nethanel the son of Zuar was over the army of the tribe of the children of Issachar. ¹⁶Eliab the son of Helon was over the army of the tribe of the children of Zebulun. ¹⁷The tabernacle was taken down; and the sons of Gershon and the sons of Merari, who bore the tabernacle, went forward. ¹⁸The standard of the camp of Reuben went forward according to their armies. Elizur the son of Shedeur was over his army. ¹⁹Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai was over the army of the tribe of the children of Simeon. ²⁰Eliasaph the son of Deuel was over the army of the tribe of the children of Gad. ²¹The Kohathites set forward, bearing the sanctuary. The others set up the tabernacle before they arrived. ²²The standard of the camp of the children of Ephraim set forward according to their armies. Elishama the son of Ammihud was over his army. ²³Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur was over the army of the tribe of the children of Manasseh. ²⁴Abidan the son of Gideon was over the army of the tribe of the children of Benjamin. ²⁵The standard of the camp of the children of Dan, which was the rear guard of all the camps, set forward according to their armies. Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai was over his army. ²⁶Pagiel the son of Ochran was over the army of the tribe of the children of Asher. ²⁷Ahira the son of Enan was over the army of the tribe of the children of Naphtali. ²⁸Thus were the travels of the children of Israel according to their armies; and they went forward. ²⁹Moses said to Hobab, the son of Reuel the Midianite, Moses' father-in-law, "We are journeying to the place of which the LORD said, 'I will give it to you.' Come with us, and we will treat you well; for the LORD has spoken good concerning Israel." ³⁰He said to him, "I will not go; but I will depart to my own land, and to my relatives." ³¹Moses said, "Don't leave us, please; because you know how we are to encamp in the wilderness, and you can be our eyes. ³²It shall be, if you go with us—yes, it shall be—that whatever good the LORD does to us, we will do the same to you." ³³They set forward from the Mount of the LORD three days' journey. The ark of the LORD's covenant went before them three days' journey, to seek out a resting place for them. ³⁴The cloud of the LORD was over them by day, when they set forward from the camp. ³⁵When the ark went forward, Moses said, "Rise up, LORD, and let your enemies be scattered! Let those who hate you flee before you!" ³⁶When it rested, he said, "Return, LORD, to the ten thousands of the thousands of Israel."

11 The people were complaining in the ears of the LORD. When the LORD heard it, his anger burned; and the LORD's fire burned among them, and consumed some of the outskirts of the camp. ²The people cried to Moses; and Moses

prayed to the LORD, and the fire abated. ³The name of that place was called Taberah, ^{xvi} because the LORD's fire burned among them. ⁴The mixed multitude that was among them lusted exceedingly; and the children of Israel also wept again, and said, "Who will give us meat to eat? ⁵We remember the fish, which we ate in Egypt for nothing; the cucumbers, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlic; ⁶but now we have lost our appetite. There is nothing at all except this manna to look at." ⁷The manna was like coriander seed, and it looked like bdellium. ^{xvii} ⁸The people went around, gathered it, and ground it in mills, or beat it in mortars, and boiled it in pots, and made cakes of it. Its taste was like the taste of fresh oil. ⁹When the dew fell on the camp in the night, the manna fell on it. ¹⁰Moses heard the people weeping throughout their families, every man at the door of his tent; and the LORD's anger burned greatly; and Moses was displeased. ¹¹Moses said to the LORD, "Why have you treated your servant so badly? Why haven't I found favor in your sight, that you lay the burden of all this people on me? ¹²Have I conceived all this people? Have I brought them out, that you should tell me, 'Carry them in your bosom, as a nurse carries a nursing infant, to the land which you swore to their fathers?' ¹³Where could I get meat to give all these people? For they weep before me, saying, 'Give us meat, that we may eat.' ¹⁴I am not able to bear all this people alone, because it is too heavy for me. ¹⁵If you treat me this way, please kill me right now, if I have found favor in your sight; and don't let me see my wretchedness." ¹⁶The LORD said to Moses, "Gather to me seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom you know to be the elders of the people and officers over them; and bring them to the Tent of Meeting, that they may stand there with you. ¹⁷I will come down and talk with you there. I will take of the Spirit which is on you, and will put it on them; and they shall bear the burden of the people with you, that you don't bear it yourself alone. ¹⁸Say to the people, 'Sanctify yourselves in preparation for tomorrow, and you will eat meat; for you have wept in the ears of the LORD, saying, "Who will give us meat to eat? For it was well with us in Egypt." Therefore the LORD will give you meat, and you will eat. ¹⁹You will not eat just one day, or two days, or five days, or ten days, or twenty days, ²⁰but a whole month, until it comes out at your nostrils, and it is loathsome to you; because you have rejected the LORD who is among you, and have wept before him, saying, "Why did we come out of Egypt?"' " ²¹Moses said, "The people, among whom I am, are six hundred thousand men on foot; and you have said, 'I will give them meat, that they may eat a whole month.' ²²Shall flocks and herds be slaughtered for them, to be sufficient for them? Shall all the fish of the sea be gathered together for them, to be sufficient for them?" ²³The

^{xvi}Taberah means "burning"

^{xvii}Bdellium is a resin extracted from certain African trees.

LORD said to Moses, "Has the LORD's hand grown short? Now you will see whether my word will happen to you or not." ²⁴Moses went out, and told the people the LORD's words; and he gathered seventy men of the elders of the people, and set them around the Tent. ²⁵The LORD came down in the cloud, and spoke to him, and took of the Spirit that was on him, and put it on the seventy elders. When the Spirit rested on them, they prophesied, but they did so no more. ²⁶But two men remained in the camp. The name of one was Eldad, and the name of the other Medad; and the Spirit rested on them. They were of those who were written, but had not gone out to the Tent; and they prophesied in the camp. ²⁷A young man ran, and told Moses, and said, "Eldad and Medad are prophesying in the camp!" ²⁸Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of Moses, one of his chosen men, answered, "My lord Moses, forbid them!" ²⁹Moses said to him, "Are you jealous for my sake? I wish that all the LORD's people were prophets, that the LORD would put his Spirit on them!" ³⁰Moses went into the camp, he and the elders of Israel. ³¹A wind from the LORD went out and brought quails from the sea, and let them fall by the camp, about a day's journey on this side, and a day's journey on the other side, around the camp, and about two cubits ^{xviii} above the surface of the earth. ³²The people rose up all that day, and all of that night, and all the next day, and gathered the quails. He who gathered least gathered ten homers; ^{xix} and they spread them all out for themselves around the camp. ³³While the meat was still between their teeth, before it was chewed, the LORD's anger burned against the people, and the LORD struck the people with a very great plague. ³⁴The name of that place was called Kibroth Hattaavah, ^{xx} because there they buried the people who lusted. ³⁵From Kibroth Hattaavah the people traveled to Hazeroth; and they stayed at Hazeroth.

12 Miriam and Aaron spoke against Moses because of the Cushite woman whom he had married; for he had married a Cushite woman. ²They said, "Has the LORD indeed spoken only with Moses? Hasn't he spoken also with us?" And the LORD heard it. ³Now the man Moses was very humble, more than all the men who were on the surface of the earth. ⁴The LORD spoke suddenly to Moses, to Aaron, and to Miriam, "You three come out to the Tent of Meeting!" The three of them came out. ⁵The LORD came down in a pillar of cloud, and stood at the door of the Tent, and called Aaron and Miriam; and they both came forward. ⁶He said, "Now hear my words. If there is a prophet among you, I, the LORD, will make myself known to him in a vision. I will speak with him in a dream.

⁷My servant Moses is not so. He is faithful in all my house. ⁸With him, I will speak mouth to mouth, even plainly, and not in riddles; and he shall see the LORD's form. Why then were you not afraid to speak against my servant, against Moses?" ⁹The LORD's anger burned against them; and he departed. ¹⁰The cloud departed from over the Tent; and behold, Miriam was leprous, as white as snow. Aaron looked at Miriam, and behold, she was leprous. ¹¹Aaron said to Moses, "Oh, my lord, please don't count this sin against us, in which we have done foolishly, and in which we have sinned. ¹²Let her not, I pray, be as one dead, of whom the flesh is half consumed when he comes out of his mother's womb." ¹³Moses cried to the LORD, saying, "Heal her, God, I beg you!" ¹⁴The LORD said to Moses, "If her father had but spit in her face, shouldn't she be ashamed seven days? Let her be shut up outside of the camp seven days, and after that she shall be brought in again." ¹⁵Miriam was shut up outside of the camp seven days, and the people didn't travel until Miriam was brought in again. ¹⁶Afterward the people traveled from Hazeroth, and encamped in the wilderness of Paran.

13 The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Send men, that they may spy out the land of Canaan, which I give to the children of Israel. Of every tribe of their fathers, you shall send a man, every one a prince among them." ³Moses sent them from the wilderness of Paran according to the commandment of the LORD. All of them were men who were heads of the children of Israel. ⁴These were their names: Of the tribe of Reuben, Shammua the son of Zaccur. ⁵Of the tribe of Simeon, Shaphat the son of Hori. ⁶Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh. ⁷Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph. ⁸Of the tribe of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Nun. ⁹Of the tribe of Benjamin, Palti the son of Raphu. ¹⁰Of the tribe of Zebulun, Gaddiel the son of Sodi. ¹¹Of the tribe of Joseph, of the tribe of Manasseh, Gaddi the son of Susi. ¹²Of the tribe of Dan, Amiel the son of Gemalli. ¹³Of the tribe of Asher, Sethur the son of Michael. ¹⁴Of the tribe of Naphtali, Nahbi the son of Vophsi. ¹⁵Of the tribe of Gad, Geuel the son of Machi. ¹⁶These are the names of the men who Moses sent to spy out the land. Moses called Hoshea the son of Nun Joshua. ¹⁷Moses sent them to spy out the land of Canaan, and said to them, "Go up this way by the South, and go up into the hill country. ¹⁸See the land, what it is; and the people who dwell therein, whether they are strong or weak, whether they are few or many; ¹⁹and what the land is that they dwell in, whether it is good or bad; and what cities they are that they dwell in, whether in camps, or in strongholds; ²⁰and what the land is, whether it is fertile or poor, whether there is wood therein, or not. Be courageous, and bring some of the fruit of the land." Now the time was the time of the first-ripe grapes. ²¹So they went

^{xviii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xix}1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

^{xx}Kibroth Hattaavah means "graves of lust"

up, and spied out the land from the wilderness of Zin to Rehob, to the entrance of Hamath. ²²They went up by the South, and came to Hebron; and Ahiman, Sheshai, and Talmai, the children of Anak, were there. (Now Hebron was built seven years before Zoan in Egypt.) ²³They came to the valley of Eshcol, and cut down from there a branch with one cluster of grapes, and they bore it on a staff between two. They also brought some of the pomegranates and figs. ²⁴That place was called the valley of Eshcol, because of the cluster which the children of Israel cut down from there. ²⁵They returned from spying out the land at the end of forty days. ²⁶They went and came to Moses, to Aaron, and to all the congregation of the children of Israel, to the wilderness of Paran, to Kadesh; and brought back word to them and to all the congregation. They showed them the fruit of the land. ²⁷They told him, and said, "We came to the land where you sent us. Surely it flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. ²⁸However, the people who dwell in the land are strong, and the cities are fortified and very large. Moreover, we saw the children of Anak there. ²⁹Amalek dwells in the land of the South. The Hittite, the Jebusite, and the Amorite dwell in the hill country. The Canaanite dwells by the sea, and along the side of the Jordan." ³⁰Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, "Let's go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it!" ³¹But the men who went up with him said, "We aren't able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we." ³²They brought up an evil report of the land which they had spied out to the children of Israel, saying, "The land, through which we have gone to spy it out, is a land that eats up its inhabitants; and all the people who we saw in it are men of great stature. ³³There we saw the Nephilim, ^{xxi} the sons of Anak, who come from the Nephilim. ^{xxii} We were in our own sight as grasshoppers, and so we were in their sight."

¹⁴All the congregation lifted up their voice, and cried; and the people wept that night. ²All the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron. The whole congregation said to them, "We wish that we had died in the land of Egypt, or that we had died in this wilderness! ³Why does the LORD bring us to this land, to fall by the sword? Our wives and our little ones will be captured or killed! Wouldn't it be better for us to return into Egypt?" ⁴They said to one another, "Let's choose a leader, and let's return into Egypt." ⁵Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel. ⁶Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were of those who spied out the land, tore their clothes. ⁷They spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, "The land, which we passed through to spy it out, is an exceedingly good land. ⁸If the

LORD delights in us, then he will bring us into this land, and give it to us: a land which flows with milk and honey. ⁹Only don't rebel against the LORD, neither fear the people of the land; for they are bread for us. Their defense is removed from over them, and the LORD is with us. Don't fear them." ¹⁰But all the congregation threatened to stone them with stones. The LORD's glory appeared in the Tent of Meeting to all the children of Israel. ¹¹The LORD said to Moses, "How long will this people despise me? How long will they not believe in me, for all the signs which I have worked among them? ¹²I will strike them with the pestilence, and disinherit them, and will make of you a nation greater and mightier than they." ¹³Moses said to the LORD, "Then the Egyptians will hear it; for you brought up this people in your might from among them. ¹⁴They will tell it to the inhabitants of this land. They have heard that you LORD are among this people; for you LORD are seen face to face, and your cloud stands over them, and you go before them, in a pillar of cloud by day, and in a pillar of fire by night. ¹⁵Now if you killed this people as one man, then the nations which have heard the fame of you will speak, saying, ¹⁶'Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land which he swore to them, therefore he has slain them in the wilderness.' ¹⁷Now please let the power of the Lord ^{xxiii} be great, according as you have spoken, saying, ¹⁸'The LORD is slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, forgiving iniquity and disobedience; and he will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, on the third and on the fourth generation.' ¹⁹Please pardon the iniquity of this people according to the greatness of your loving kindness, and just as you have forgiven this people, from Egypt even until now." ²⁰The LORD said, "I have pardoned according to your word; ²¹but in very deed—as I live, and as all the earth shall be filled with the LORD's glory— ²²because all those men who have seen my glory and my signs, which I worked in Egypt and in the wilderness, yet have tempted me these ten times, and have not listened to my voice; ²³surely they shall not see the land which I swore to their fathers, neither shall any of those who despised me see it. ²⁴But my servant Caleb, because he had another spirit with him, and has followed me fully, him I will bring into the land into which he went. His offspring shall possess it. ²⁵Since the Amalekite and the Canaanite dwell in the valley, tomorrow turn and go into the wilderness by the way to the Sea of Suf." ²⁶The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²⁷"How long shall I bear with this evil congregation that complain against me? I have heard the complaints of the children of Israel, which they complain against me. ²⁸Tell them, 'As I live, says the LORD, surely as you have spoken in my ears, so I will do to you. ²⁹Your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness; and all who were counted of you, according to your

^{xxi}or, giants

^{xxii}or, giants

^{xxiii}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

whole number, from twenty years old and upward, who have complained against me, ³⁰surely you shall not come into the land concerning which I swore that I would make you dwell therein, except Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun. ³¹But I will bring in your little ones that you said should be captured or killed, and they shall know the land which you have rejected. ³²But as for you, your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness. ³³Your children shall be wanderers in the wilderness forty years, and shall bear your prostitution, until your dead bodies are consumed in the wilderness. ³⁴After the number of the days in which you spied out the land, even forty days, for every day a year, you will bear your iniquities, even forty years, and you will know my alienation.’ ³⁵I, the LORD, have spoken. I will surely do this to all this evil congregation who are gathered together against me. In this wilderness they shall be consumed, and there they shall die.” ³⁶The men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the congregation to murmur against him by bringing up an evil report against the land, ³⁷even those men who brought up an evil report of the land, died by the plague before the LORD. ³⁸But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh remained alive of those men who went to spy out the land. ³⁹Moses told these words to all the children of Israel, and the people mourned greatly. ⁴⁰They rose up early in the morning and went up to the top of the mountain, saying, “Behold, we are here, and will go up to the place which the LORD has promised; for we have sinned.” ⁴¹Moses said, “Why now do you disobey the commandment of the LORD, since it shall not prosper? ⁴²Don’t go up, for the LORD isn’t among you; that way you won’t be struck down before your enemies. ⁴³For there the Amalekite and the Canaanite are before you, and you will fall by the sword because you turned back from following the LORD; therefore the LORD will not be with you.” ⁴⁴But they presumed to go up to the top of the mountain. Nevertheless, the ark of the LORD’s covenant and Moses didn’t depart out of the camp. ⁴⁵Then the Amalekites came down, and the Canaanites who lived in that mountain, and struck them and beat them down even to Hormah.

15The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘When you have come into the land of your habitations, which I give to you, ³and will make an offering by fire to the LORD—a burnt offering, or a sacrifice, to accomplish a vow, or as a free will offering, or in your set feasts, to make a pleasant aroma to the LORD, of the herd, or of the flock— ⁴then he who offers his offering shall offer to the LORD a meal offering of one tenth of an ephah ^{xxiv} of fine flour mixed with one fourth of a hin ^{xxv} of oil. ⁵You shall prepare wine for the drink offering, one

fourth of a hin, with the burnt offering or for the sacrifice, for each lamb. ⁶“For a ram, you shall prepare for a meal offering two tenths of an ephah ^{xxvi} of fine flour mixed with the third part of a hin of oil; ⁷and for the drink offering you shall offer the third part of a hin of wine, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ⁸When you prepare a bull for a burnt offering or for a sacrifice, to accomplish a vow, or for peace offerings to the LORD, ⁹then he shall offer with the bull a meal offering of three tenths of an ephah ^{xxvii} of fine flour mixed with half a hin of oil; ¹⁰and you shall offer for the drink offering half a hin of wine, for an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹¹Thus it shall be done for each bull, for each ram, for each of the male lambs, or of the young goats. ¹²According to the number that you shall prepare, so you shall do to everyone according to their number. ¹³“All who are native-born shall do these things in this way, in offering an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹⁴If a stranger lives as a foreigner with you, or whoever may be among you throughout your generations, and will offer an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD, as you do, so he shall do. ¹⁵For the assembly, there shall be one statute for you and for the stranger who lives as a foreigner, a statute forever throughout your generations. As you are, so the foreigner shall be before the LORD. ¹⁶One law and one ordinance shall be for you and for the stranger who lives as a foreigner with you.’” ¹⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁸“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘When you come into the land where I bring you, ¹⁹then it shall be that when you eat of the bread of the land, you shall offer up a wave offering to the LORD. ²⁰Of the first of your dough you shall offer up a cake for a wave offering. As the wave offering of the threshing floor, so you shall heave it. ²¹Of the first of your dough, you shall give to the LORD a wave offering throughout your generations. ²²“When you err, and don’t observe all these commandments which the LORD has spoken to Moses— ²³even all that the LORD has commanded you by Moses, from the day that the LORD gave commandment and onward throughout your generations— ²⁴then it shall be, if it was done unwittingly, without the knowledge of the congregation, that all the congregation shall offer one young bull for a burnt offering, for a pleasant aroma to the LORD, with its meal offering and its drink offering, according to the ordinance, and one male goat for a sin offering. ²⁵The priest shall make atonement for all the congregation of the children of Israel, and they shall be forgiven; for it was an error, and they have brought their offering, an offering made by fire to the LORD, and their sin offering before the LORD, for their error. ²⁶All the congregation of the children of Israel shall be forgiven, as well as the stranger who lives as a foreigner among them; for with regard to all

^{xxiv}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxv}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

^{xxvi}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxvii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

the people, it was done unwittingly. ²⁷“If a person sins unwittingly, then he shall offer a female goat a year old for a sin offering. ²⁸The priest shall make atonement for the soul who errs when he sins unwittingly before the LORD. He shall make atonement for him; and he shall be forgiven. ²⁹You shall have one law for him who does anything unwittingly, for him who is native-born among the children of Israel, and for the stranger who lives as a foreigner among them. ³⁰“But the soul who does anything with a high hand, whether he is native-born or a foreigner, blasphemes the LORD. That soul shall be cut off from among his people. ³¹Because he has despised the LORD’s word, and has broken his commandment, that soul shall be utterly cut off. His iniquity shall be on him.” ³²While the children of Israel were in the wilderness, they found a man gathering sticks on the Sabbath day. ³³Those who found him gathering sticks brought him to Moses and Aaron, and to all the congregation. ³⁴They put him in custody, because it had not been declared what should be done to him. ³⁵The LORD said to Moses, “The man shall surely be put to death. All the congregation shall stone him with stones outside of the camp.” ³⁶All the congregation brought him outside of the camp, and stoned him to death with stones, as the LORD commanded Moses. ³⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ³⁸“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them that they should make themselves fringes ^{xxviii} on the borders of their garments throughout their generations, and that they put on the fringe ^{xxix} of each border a cord of blue. ³⁹It shall be to you for a fringe, ^{xxx} that you may see it, and remember all the LORD’s commandments, and do them; and that you don’t follow your own heart and your own eyes, after which you used to play the prostitute; ⁴⁰so that you may remember and do all my commandments, and be holy to your God. ⁴¹I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, to be your God: I am the LORD your God.”

16Now Korah, the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, with Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, and On, the son of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took some men. ²They rose up before Moses, with some of the children of Israel, two hundred fifty princes of the congregation, called to the assembly, men of renown. ³They assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron, and said to them, “You take too much on yourself, since all the congregation are holy, everyone of them, and the LORD is among them! Why do you lift yourselves up above the LORD’s assembly?” ⁴When Moses heard it, he fell on his face. ⁵He said to Korah and to all his company, “In the morning, the LORD will show who are his, and who is holy, and will cause him to come near to him. Even

him whom he shall choose, he will cause to come near to him. ⁶Do this: have Korah and all his company take censers, ⁷put fire in them, and put incense on them before the LORD tomorrow. It shall be that the man whom the LORD chooses, he shall be holy. You have gone too far, you sons of Levi!” ⁸Moses said to Korah, “Hear now, you sons of Levi! ⁹Is it a small thing to you that the God of Israel has separated you from the congregation of Israel, to bring you near to himself, to do the service of the LORD’s tabernacle, and to stand before the congregation to minister to them; ¹⁰and that he has brought you near, and all your brothers the sons of Levi with you? Do you seek the priesthood also? ¹¹Therefore you and all your company have gathered together against the LORD! What is Aaron that you complain against him?” ¹²Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab; and they said, “We won’t come up! ¹³Is it a small thing that you have brought us up out of a land flowing with milk and honey, to kill us in the wilderness, but you must also make yourself a prince over us? ¹⁴Moreover you haven’t brought us into a land flowing with milk and honey, nor given us inheritance of fields and vineyards. Will you put out the eyes of these men? We won’t come up.” ¹⁵Moses was very angry, and said to the LORD, “Don’t respect their offering. I have not taken one donkey from them, neither have I hurt one of them.” ¹⁶Moses said to Korah, “You and all your company go before the LORD, you, and they, and Aaron, tomorrow. ¹⁷Each man take his censer and put incense on it, and each man bring before the LORD his censer, two hundred fifty censers; you also, and Aaron, each with his censer.” ¹⁸They each took his censer, and put fire in it, and laid incense on it, and stood at the door of the Tent of Meeting with Moses and Aaron. ¹⁹Korah assembled all the congregation opposite them to the door of the Tent of Meeting. The LORD’s glory appeared to all the congregation. ²⁰The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²¹“Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment!” ²²They fell on their faces, and said, “God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, shall one man sin, and will you be angry with all the congregation?” ²³The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁴“Speak to the congregation, saying, ‘Get away from around the tent of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram!’” ²⁵Moses rose up and went to Dathan and Abiram; and the elders of Israel followed him. ²⁶He spoke to the congregation, saying, “Depart, please, from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest you be consumed in all their sins!” ²⁷So they went away from the tent of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every side. Dathan and Abiram came out, and stood at the door of their tents with their wives, their sons, and their little ones. ²⁸Moses said, “Hereby you shall know that the LORD has sent me to do all these works; for they are not from my own mind. ²⁹If these men die the common death of all men, or if they experience what all men experi-

^{xxviii}or, tzitziot (Hebrew (

^{xxix}or, tassel

^{xxx}or, tassel

ence, then the LORD hasn't sent me. ³⁰But if the LORD makes a new thing, and the ground opens its mouth, and swallows them up with all that belong to them, and they go down alive into Sheol, ^{xxxix} then you shall understand that these men have despised the LORD." ³¹As he finished speaking all these words, the ground that was under them split apart. ³²The earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up with their households, all of Korah's men, and all their goods. ³³So they, and all that belonged to them went down alive into Sheol. ^{xxxix} The earth closed on them, and they perished from among the assembly. ³⁴All Israel that were around them fled at their cry; for they said, "Lest the earth swallow us up!" ³⁵Fire came out from the LORD, and devoured the two hundred fifty men who offered the incense. ³⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ³⁷"Speak to Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, that he take up the censers out of the burning, and scatter the fire away from the camp; for they are holy, ³⁸even the censers of those who sinned against their own lives. Let them be beaten into plates for a covering of the altar, for they offered them before the LORD. Therefore they are holy. They shall be a sign to the children of Israel." ³⁹Eleazar the priest took the bronze censers which those who were burned had offered; and they beat them out for a covering of the altar, ⁴⁰to be a memorial to the children of Israel, to the end that no stranger who isn't of the offspring of Aaron, would come near to burn incense before the LORD, that he not be as Korah and as his company; as the LORD spoke to him by Moses. ⁴¹But on the next day all the congregation of the children of Israel complained against Moses and against Aaron, saying, "You have killed the LORD's people!" ⁴²When the congregation was assembled against Moses and against Aaron, they looked toward the Tent of Meeting. Behold, the cloud covered it, and the LORD's glory appeared. ⁴³Moses and Aaron came to the front of the Tent of Meeting. ⁴⁴The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁴⁵"Get away from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment!" They fell on their faces. ⁴⁶Moses said to Aaron, "Take your censer, put fire from the altar in it, lay incense on it, carry it quickly to the congregation, and make atonement for them; for wrath has gone out from the LORD! The plague has begun." ⁴⁷Aaron did as Moses said, and ran into the middle of the assembly. The plague had already begun among the people. He put on the incense, and made atonement for the people. ⁴⁸He stood between the dead and the living; and the plague was stayed. ⁴⁹Now those who died by the plague were fourteen thousand seven hundred, in addition to those who died about the matter of Korah. ⁵⁰Aaron returned to Moses to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and the plague was stopped.

^{xxxix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xxxix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

¹⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Speak to the children of Israel, and take rods from them, one for each fathers' house, of all their princes according to their fathers' houses, twelve rods. Write each man's name on his rod. ³You shall write Aaron's name on Levi's rod. There shall be one rod for each head of their fathers' houses. ⁴You shall lay them up in the Tent of Meeting before the covenant, where I meet with you. ⁵It shall happen that the rod of the man whom I shall choose shall bud. I will make the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against you, cease from me." ⁶Moses spoke to the children of Israel; and all their princes gave him rods, for each prince one, according to their fathers' houses, a total of twelve rods. Aaron's rod was among their rods. ⁷Moses laid up the rods before the LORD in the Tent of the Testimony. ⁸On the next day, Moses went into the Tent of the Testimony; and behold, Aaron's rod for the house of Levi had sprouted, budded, produced blossoms, and bore ripe almonds. ⁹Moses brought out all the rods from before the LORD to all the children of Israel. They looked, and each man took his rod. ¹⁰The LORD said to Moses, "Put back the rod of Aaron before the covenant, to be kept for a token against the children of rebellion; that you may make an end of their complaining against me, that they not die." ¹¹Moses did so. As the LORD commanded him, so he did. ¹²The children of Israel spoke to Moses, saying, "Behold, we perish! We are undone! We are all undone! ¹³Everyone who keeps approaching the LORD's tabernacle, dies! Will we all perish?"

¹⁸The LORD said to Aaron, "You and your sons and your fathers' house with you shall bear the iniquity of the sanctuary; and you and your sons with you shall bear the iniquity of your priesthood. ²Bring your brothers also, the tribe of Levi, the tribe of your father, near with you, that they may be joined to you, and minister to you; but you and your sons with you shall be before the Tent of the Testimony. ³They shall keep your commands and the duty of the whole Tent; only they shall not come near to the vessels of the sanctuary and to the altar, that they not die, neither they nor you. ⁴They shall be joined to you and keep the responsibility of the Tent of Meeting, for all the service of the Tent. A stranger shall not come near to you. ⁵"You shall perform the duty of the sanctuary and the duty of the altar, that there be no more wrath on the children of Israel. ⁶Behold, I myself have taken your brothers the Levites from among the children of Israel. They are a gift to you, dedicated to the LORD, to do the service of the Tent of Meeting. ⁷You and your sons with you shall keep your priesthood for everything of the altar, and for that within the veil. You shall serve. I give you the service of the priesthood as a gift. The stranger who comes near shall be put to death." ⁸The LORD spoke to Aaron, "Behold, I myself have given you the command

of my wave offerings, even all the holy things of the children of Israel. I have given them to you by reason of the anointing, and to your sons, as a portion forever. ⁹This shall be yours of the most holy things from the fire: every offering of theirs, even every meal offering of theirs, and every sin offering of theirs, and every trespass offering of theirs, which they shall render to me, shall be most holy for you and for your sons. ¹⁰You shall eat of it like the most holy things. Every male shall eat of it. It shall be holy to you. ¹¹“This is yours, too: the wave offering of their gift, even all the wave offerings of the children of Israel. I have given them to you, and to your sons and to your daughters with you, as a portion forever. Everyone who is clean in your house shall eat of it. ¹²“I have given to you all the best of the oil, all the best of the vintage, and of the grain, the first fruits of them which they give to the LORD. ¹³The first-ripe fruits of all that is in their land, which they bring to the LORD, shall be yours. Everyone who is clean in your house shall eat of it. ¹⁴“Everything devoted in Israel shall be yours. ¹⁵Everything that opens the womb, of all flesh which they offer to the LORD, both of man and animal, shall be yours. Nevertheless, you shall surely redeem the firstborn of man, and you shall redeem the firstborn of unclean animals. ¹⁶You shall redeem those who are to be redeemed of them from a month old, according to your estimation, for five shekels of money, according to the shekel ^{xxxiii} of the sanctuary, which weighs twenty gerahs. ^{xxxiv} ¹⁷“But you shall not redeem the firstborn of a cow, or the firstborn of a sheep, or the firstborn of a goat. They are holy. You shall sprinkle their blood on the altar, and shall burn their fat for an offering made by fire, for a pleasant aroma to the LORD. ¹⁸Their meat shall be yours, as the wave offering breast and as the right thigh, it shall be yours. ¹⁹All the wave offerings of the holy things which the children of Israel offer to the LORD, I have given you and your sons and your daughters with you, as a portion forever. It is a covenant of salt forever before the LORD to you and to your offspring with you.” ²⁰The LORD said to Aaron, “You shall have no inheritance in their land, neither shall you have any portion among them. I am your portion and your inheritance among the children of Israel. ²¹“To the children of Levi, behold, I have given all the tithe in Israel for an inheritance, in return for their service which they serve, even the service of the Tent of Meeting. ²²Henceforth the children of Israel shall not come near the Tent of Meeting, lest they bear sin, and die. ²³But the Levites shall do the service of the Tent of Meeting, and they shall bear their iniquity. It shall be a statute forever throughout your generations. Among the children of Israel, they shall have no inheritance. ²⁴For the tithe of the children of Israel, which they offer as a wave offering to the LORD, I have given to the Levites for an inheri-

tance. Therefore I have said to them, ‘Among the children of Israel they shall have no inheritance.’” ²⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁶“Moreover you shall speak to the Levites, and tell them, ‘When you take of the children of Israel the tithe which I have given you from them for your inheritance, then you shall offer up a wave offering of it for the LORD, a tithe of the tithe. ²⁷Your wave offering shall be credited to you, as though it were the grain of the threshing floor, and as the fullness of the wine press. ²⁸Thus you also shall offer a wave offering to the LORD of all your tithes, which you receive of the children of Israel; and of it you shall give the LORD’s wave offering to Aaron the priest. ²⁹Out of all your gifts, you shall offer every wave offering to the LORD, of all its best parts, even the holy part of it.’ ³⁰“Therefore you shall tell them, ‘When you heave its best from it, then it shall be credited to the Levites as the increase of the threshing floor, and as the increase of the wine press. ³¹You may eat it anywhere, you and your households, for it is your reward in return for your service in the Tent of Meeting. ³²You shall bear no sin by reason of it, when you have heaved from it its best. You shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, that you not die.’”

¹⁹The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, ²“This is the statute of the law which the LORD has commanded. Tell the children of Israel to bring you a red heifer without spot, in which is no defect, and which was never yoked. ³You shall give her to Eleazar the priest, and he shall bring her outside of the camp, and one shall kill her before his face. ⁴Eleazar the priest shall take some of her blood with his finger, and sprinkle her blood toward the front of the Tent of Meeting seven times. ⁵One shall burn the heifer in his sight; her skin, and her meat, and her blood, with her dung, shall he burn. ⁶The priest shall take cedar wood, hyssop, and scarlet, and cast it into the middle of the burning of the heifer. ⁷Then the priest shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp, and the priest shall be unclean until the evening. ⁸He who burns her shall wash his clothes in water, and bathe his flesh in water, and shall be unclean until the evening. ⁹“A man who is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer, and lay them up outside of the camp in a clean place; and it shall be kept for the congregation of the children of Israel for use in water for cleansing impurity. It is a sin offering. ¹⁰He who gathers the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. It shall be to the children of Israel, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among them, for a statute forever. ¹¹“He who touches the dead body of any man shall be unclean seven days. ¹²He shall purify himself with water on the third day, and on the seventh day he shall be clean; but if he doesn’t purify himself the third day, then the seventh day he shall not

^{xxxiii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xxxiv}A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains.

be clean. ¹³Whoever touches a dead person, the body of a man who has died, and doesn't purify himself, defiles the LORD's tabernacle; and that soul shall be cut off from Israel; because the water for impurity was not sprinkled on him, he shall be unclean. His uncleanness is yet on him. ¹⁴"This is the law when a man dies in a tent: everyone who comes into the tent, and everyone who is in the tent, shall be unclean seven days. ¹⁵Every open vessel, which has no covering bound on it, is unclean. ¹⁶"Whoever in the open field touches one who is slain with a sword, or a dead body, or a bone of a man, or a grave, shall be unclean seven days. ¹⁷"For the unclean, they shall take of the ashes of the burning of the sin offering; and running water shall be poured on them in a vessel. ¹⁸A clean person shall take hyssop, dip it in the water, and sprinkle it on the tent, on all the vessels, on the persons who were there, and on him who touched the bone, or the slain, or the dead, or the grave. ¹⁹The clean person shall sprinkle on the unclean on the third day, and on the seventh day. On the seventh day, he shall purify him. He shall wash his clothes and bathe himself in water, and shall be clean at evening. ²⁰But the man who shall be unclean, and shall not purify himself, that soul shall be cut off from among the assembly, because he has defiled the sanctuary of the LORD. The water for impurity has not been sprinkled on him. He is unclean. ²¹It shall be a perpetual statute to them. He who sprinkles the water for impurity shall wash his clothes, and he who touches the water for impurity shall be unclean until evening. ²²"Whatever the unclean person touches shall be unclean; and the soul that touches it shall be unclean until evening."

20The children of Israel, even the whole congregation, came into the wilderness of Zin in the first month. The people stayed in Kadesh. Miriam died there, and was buried there. ²There was no water for the congregation; and they assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron. ³The people quarreled with Moses, and spoke, saying, "We wish that we had died when our brothers died before the LORD! ⁴Why have you brought the LORD's assembly into this wilderness, that we should die there, we and our animals? ⁵Why have you made us to come up out of Egypt, to bring us in to this evil place? It is no place of seed, or of figs, or of vines, or of pomegranates; neither is there any water to drink." ⁶Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and fell on their faces. The LORD's glory appeared to them. ⁷The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁸"Take the rod, and assemble the congregation, you, and Aaron your brother, and speak to the rock before their eyes, that it pour out its water. You shall bring water to them out of the rock; so you shall give the congregation and their livestock drink." ⁹Moses took the rod from before the LORD, as he commanded him. ¹⁰Moses and

Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock, and he said to them, "Hear now, you rebels! Shall we bring water out of this rock for you?" ¹¹Moses lifted up his hand, and struck the rock with his rod twice, and water came out abundantly. The congregation and their livestock drank. ¹²The LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "Because you didn't believe in me, to sanctify me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land which I have given them." ¹³These are the waters of Meribah; ^{xxxv} because the children of Israel strove with the LORD, and he was sanctified in them. ¹⁴Moses sent messengers from Kadesh to the king of Edom, saying: "Your brother Israel says: You know all the travail that has happened to us; ¹⁵how our fathers went down into Egypt, and we lived in Egypt a long time. The Egyptians mistreated us and our fathers. ¹⁶When we cried to the LORD, he heard our voice, sent an angel, and brought us out of Egypt. Behold, we are in Kadesh, a city in the edge of your border. ¹⁷"Please let us pass through your land. We will not pass through field or through vineyard, neither will we drink from the water of the wells. We will go along the king's highway. We will not turn away to the right hand nor to the left, until we have passed your border." ¹⁸Edom said to him, "You shall not pass through me, lest I come out with the sword against you." ¹⁹The children of Israel said to him, "We will go up by the highway; and if we drink your water, I and my livestock, then I will give its price. Only let me, without doing anything else, pass through on my feet." ²⁰He said, "You shall not pass through." Edom came out against him with many people, and with a strong hand. ²¹Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his border, so Israel turned away from him. ²²They traveled from Kadesh, and the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, came to Mount Hor. ²³The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron in Mount Hor, by the border of the land of Edom, saying, ²⁴"Aaron shall be gathered to his people; for he shall not enter into the land which I have given to the children of Israel, because you rebelled against my word at the waters of Meribah. ²⁵Take Aaron and Eleazar his son, and bring them up to Mount Hor; ²⁶and strip Aaron of his garments, and put them on Eleazar his son. Aaron shall be gathered, and shall die there." ²⁷Moses did as the LORD commanded. They went up onto Mount Hor in the sight of all the congregation. ²⁸Moses stripped Aaron of his garments, and put them on Eleazar his son. Aaron died there on the top of the mountain, and Moses and Eleazar came down from the mountain. ²⁹When all the congregation saw that Aaron was dead, they wept for Aaron thirty days, even all the house of Israel.

21The Canaanite, the king of Arad, who lived in the South, heard that Israel came by the way of Atharim.

^{xxxv}"Meribah" means "quarreling".

He fought against Israel, and took some of them captive. ²Israel vowed a vow to the LORD, and said, "If you will indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities." ³The LORD listened to the voice of Israel, and delivered up the Canaanites; and they utterly destroyed them and their cities. The name of the place was called Hormah. ^{xxxvi} ⁴They traveled from Mount Hor by the way to the Sea of Suf, to go around the land of Edom. The soul of the people was very discouraged because of the journey. ⁵The people spoke against God and against Moses: "Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? For there is no bread, there is no water, and our soul loathes this disgusting food!" ⁶The LORD sent venomous snakes among the people, and they bit the people. Many people of Israel died. ⁷The people came to Moses, and said, "We have sinned, because we have spoken against the LORD and against you. Pray to the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us." Moses prayed for the people. ⁸The LORD said to Moses, "Make a venomous snake, and set it on a pole. It shall happen that everyone who is bitten, when he sees it, shall live." ⁹Moses made a serpent of bronze, and set it on the pole. If a serpent had bitten any man, when he looked at the serpent of bronze, he lived. ¹⁰The children of Israel traveled, and encamped in Oboth. ¹¹They traveled from Oboth, and encamped at Iyeabarim, in the wilderness which is before Moab, toward the sunrise. ¹²From there they traveled, and encamped in the valley of Zered. ¹³From there they traveled, and encamped on the other side of the Arnon, which is in the wilderness that comes out of the border of the Amorites; for the Arnon is the border of Moab, between Moab and the Amorites. ¹⁴Therefore it is said in The Book of the Wars of the LORD in Suphah, the valleys of the Arnon, ¹⁵the slope of the valleys that incline toward the dwelling of Ar, leans on the border of Moab." ¹⁶From there they traveled to Beer; that is the well of which the LORD said to Moses, "Gather the people together, and I will give them water." ¹⁷Then Israel sang this song: "Spring up, well! Sing to it, ¹⁸the well, which the princes dug, which the nobles of the people dug, with the scepter, and with their poles." From the wilderness they traveled to Mattanah; ¹⁹and from Mattanah to Nahaliel; and from Nahaliel to Bamoth; ²⁰and from Bamoth to the valley that is in the field of Moab, to the top of Pisgah, which looks down on the desert. ²¹Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, saying, ²²"Let me pass through your land. We will not turn away into field or vineyard. We will not drink of the water of the wells. We will go by the king's highway, until we have passed your border." ²³Sihon would not allow Israel to pass through his border, but Sihon gathered all his people together, and went out against Israel into the wilderness, and came to Jahaz. He fought against Israel. ²⁴Israel struck him with the edge of the sword, and

possessed his land from the Arnon to the Jabbok, even to the children of Ammon; for the border of the children of Ammon was fortified. ²⁵Israel took all these cities. Israel lived in all the cities of the Amorites, in Heshbon, and in all its villages. ²⁶For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab, and taken all his land out of his hand, even to the Arnon. ²⁷Therefore those who speak in proverbs say, "Come to Heshbon. Let the city of Sihon be built and established; ²⁸for a fire has gone out of Heshbon, a flame from the city of Sihon. It has devoured Ar of Moab, The lords of the high places of the Arnon. ²⁹Woe to you, Moab! You are undone, people of Chemosh! He has given his sons as fugitives, and his daughters into captivity, to Sihon king of the Amorites. ³⁰We have shot at them. Heshbon has perished even to Dibon. We have laid waste even to Nophah, Which reaches to Medeba." ³¹Thus Israel lived in the land of the Amorites. ³²Moses sent to spy out Jazer. They took its villages, and drove out the Amorites who were there. ³³They turned and went up by the way of Bashan. Og the king of Bashan went out against them, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei. ³⁴The LORD said to Moses, "Don't fear him, for I have delivered him into your hand, with all his people, and his land. You shall do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon." ³⁵So they struck him, with his sons and all his people, until there were no survivors; and they possessed his land.

22 The children of Israel traveled, and encamped in the plains of Moab beyond the Jordan at Jericho. ²Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites. ³Moab was very afraid of the people, because they were many. Moab was distressed because of the children of Israel. ⁴Moab said to the elders of Midian, "Now this multitude will lick up all that is around us, as the ox licks up the grass of the field." Balak the son of Zippor was king of Moab at that time. ⁵He sent messengers to Balaam the son of Beor, to Pethor, which is by the River, to the land of the children of his people, to call him, saying, "Behold, there is a people who came out of Egypt. Behold, they cover the surface of the earth, and they are staying opposite me. ⁶Please come now therefore, and curse this people for me; for they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I shall prevail, that we may strike them, and that I may drive them out of the land; for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed." ⁷The elders of Moab and the elders of Midian departed with the rewards of divination in their hand. They came to Balaam, and spoke to him the words of Balak. ⁸He said to them, "Lodge here this night, and I will bring you word again, as the LORD shall speak to me." The princes of Moab stayed with Balaam. ⁹God came to Balaam, and said, "Who are these men with you?" ¹⁰Balaam said to

^{xxxvi}"Hormah" means "destruction".

God, "Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, has said to me, ¹¹'Behold, the people that has come out of Egypt covers the surface of the earth. Now, come curse them for me. Perhaps I shall be able to fight against them, and shall drive them out.'" ¹²God said to Balaam, "You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed." ¹³Balaam rose up in the morning, and said to the princes of Balak, "Go to your land; for the LORD refuses to permit me to go with you." ¹⁴The princes of Moab rose up, and they went to Balak, and said, "Balaam refuses to come with us." ¹⁵Balak again sent princes, more, and more honorable than they. ¹⁶They came to Balaam, and said to him, "Balak the son of Zippor says, 'Please let nothing hinder you from coming to me, ¹⁷for I will promote you to very great honor, and whatever you say to me I will do. Please come therefore, and curse this people for me.'" ¹⁸Balaam answered the servants of Balak, "If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I can't go beyond the word of the LORD my God, to do less or more. ¹⁹Now therefore please stay here tonight as well, that I may know what else the LORD will speak to me." ²⁰God came to Balaam at night, and said to him, "If the men have come to call you, rise up, go with them; but only the word which I speak to you, that you shall do." ²¹Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his donkey, and went with the princes of Moab. ²²God's anger burned because he went; and the LORD's angel placed himself in the way as an adversary against him. Now he was riding on his donkey, and his two servants were with him. ²³The donkey saw the LORD's angel standing in the way, with his sword drawn in his hand; and the donkey turned out of the path, and went into the field. Balaam struck the donkey, to turn her into the path. ²⁴Then the LORD's angel stood in a narrow path between the vineyards, a wall being on this side, and a wall on that side. ²⁵The donkey saw the LORD's angel, and she thrust herself to the wall, and crushed Balaam's foot against the wall. He struck her again. ²⁶The LORD's angel went further, and stood in a narrow place, where there was no way to turn either to the right hand or to the left. ²⁷The donkey saw the LORD's angel, and she lay down under Balaam. Balaam's anger burned, and he struck the donkey with his staff. ²⁸The LORD opened the mouth of the donkey, and she said to Balaam, "What have I done to you, that you have struck me these three times?" ²⁹Balaam said to the donkey, "Because you have mocked me, I wish there were a sword in my hand, for now I would have killed you." ³⁰The donkey said to Balaam, "Am I not your donkey, on which you have ridden all your life long until today? Was I ever in the habit of doing so to you?" He said, "No." ³¹Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the LORD's angel standing in the way, with his sword drawn in his hand; and he bowed his head, and fell on his face. ³²The LORD's angel said to him, "Why have you struck your donkey these three

times? Behold, I have come out as an adversary, because your way is perverse before me. ³³The donkey saw me, and turned away before me these three times. Unless she had turned away from me, surely now I would have killed you, and saved her alive." ³⁴Balaam said to the LORD's angel, "I have sinned; for I didn't know that you stood in the way against me. Now therefore, if it displeases you, I will go back again." ³⁵The LORD's angel said to Balaam, "Go with the men; but you shall only speak the word that I shall speak to you." So Balaam went with the princes of Balak. ³⁶When Balak heard that Balaam had come, he went out to meet him to the City of Moab, which is on the border of the Arnon, which is in the utmost part of the border. ³⁷Balak said to Balaam, "Didn't I earnestly send for you to summon you? Why didn't you come to me? Am I not able indeed to promote you to honor?" ³⁸Balaam said to Balak, "Behold, I have come to you. Have I now any power at all to speak anything? I will speak the word that God puts in my mouth." ³⁹Balaam went with Balak, and they came to Kiriath Huzoth. ⁴⁰Balak sacrificed cattle and sheep, and sent to Balaam, and to the princes who were with him. ⁴¹In the morning, Balak took Balaam, and brought him up into the high places of Baal; and he saw from there part of the people.

23 Balaam said to Balak, "Build here seven altars for me, and prepare here seven bulls and seven rams for me." ²Balak did as Balaam had spoken; and Balak and Balaam offered on every altar a bull and a ram. ³Balaam said to Balak, "Stand by your burnt offering, and I will go. Perhaps the LORD will come to meet me. Whatever he shows me I will tell you." He went to a bare height. ⁴God met Balaam, and he said to him, "I have prepared the seven altars, and I have offered up a bull and a ram on every altar." ⁵The LORD put a word in Balaam's mouth, and said, "Return to Balak, and thus you shall speak." ⁶He returned to him, and behold, he was standing by his burnt offering, he, and all the princes of Moab. ⁷He took up his parable, and said, "From Aram has Balak brought me, the king of Moab from the mountains of the East. Come, curse Jacob for me. Come, defy Israel. ⁸How shall I curse whom God has not cursed? How shall I defy whom the LORD has not defied? ⁹For from the top of the rocks I see him. From the hills I see him. Behold, it is a people that dwells alone, and shall not be listed among the nations. ¹⁰Who can count the dust of Jacob, or count the fourth part of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous! Let my last end be like his!" ¹¹Balak said to Balaam, "What have you done to me? I took you to curse my enemies, and behold, you have blessed them altogether." ¹²He answered and said, "Must I not take heed to speak that which the LORD puts in my mouth?" ¹³Balak said to him, "Please come with me to another place, where you may see them. You shall see just part of them, and shall not see them

all. Curse them from there for me.” ¹⁴He took him into the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars, and offered up a bull and a ram on every altar. ¹⁵He said to Balak, “Stand here by your burnt offering, while I meet God over there.” ¹⁶The LORD met Balaam, and put a word in his mouth, and said, “Return to Balak, and say this.” ¹⁷He came to him, and behold, he was standing by his burnt offering, and the princes of Moab with him. Balak said to him, “What has the LORD spoken?” ¹⁸He took up his parable, and said, “Rise up, Balak, and hear! Listen to me, you son of Zippor. ¹⁹God is not a man, that he should lie, nor a son of man, that he should repent. Has he said, and he won’t do it? Or has he spoken, and he won’t make it good? ²⁰Behold, I have received a command to bless. He has blessed, and I can’t reverse it. ²¹He has not seen iniquity in Jacob. Neither has he seen perverseness in Israel. The LORD his God is with him. The shout of a king is among them. ²²God brings them out of Egypt. He has as it were the strength of the wild ox. ²³Surely there is no enchantment with Jacob; Neither is there any divination with Israel. Now it shall be said of Jacob and of Israel, ‘What has God done!’ ²⁴Behold, a people rises up as a lioness. As a lion he lifts himself up. He shall not lie down until he eats of the prey, and drinks the blood of the slain.” ²⁵Balak said to Balaam, “Neither curse them at all, nor bless them at all.” ²⁶But Balaam answered Balak, “Didn’t I tell you, saying, ‘All that the LORD speaks, that I must do?’” ²⁷Balak said to Balaam, “Come now, I will take you to another place; perhaps it will please God that you may curse them for me from there.” ²⁸Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor, that looks down on the desert. ²⁹Balaam said to Balak, “Build seven altars for me here, and prepare seven bulls and seven rams for me here.” ³⁰Balak did as Balaam had said, and offered up a bull and a ram on every altar.

24When Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he didn’t go, as at the other times, to use divination, but he set his face toward the wilderness. ²Balaam lifted up his eyes, and he saw Israel dwelling according to their tribes; and the Spirit of God came on him. ³He took up his parable, and said, “Balaam the son of Beor says, the man whose eyes are open says; ⁴he says, who hears the words of God, who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down, and having his eyes open: ⁵How goodly are your tents, Jacob, and your dwellings, Israel! ⁶As valleys they are spread out, as gardens by the riverside, as aloes which the LORD has planted, as cedar trees beside the waters. ⁷Water shall flow from his buckets. His seed shall be in many waters. His king shall be higher than Agag. His kingdom shall be exalted. ⁸God brings him out of Egypt. He has as it were the strength of the wild ox. He shall consume the nations his adversaries, shall break their bones in pieces, and pierce them with his arrows. ⁹He couched, he lay down as a

lion, as a lioness; who shall rouse him up? Everyone who blesses you is blessed. Everyone who curses you is cursed.” ¹⁰Balak’s anger burned against Balaam, and he struck his hands together. Balak said to Balaam, “I called you to curse my enemies, and, behold, you have altogether blessed them these three times. ¹¹Therefore, flee to your place, now! I thought to promote you to great honor; but, behold, the LORD has kept you back from honor.” ¹²Balaam said to Balak, “Didn’t I also tell your messengers whom you sent to me, saying, ¹³If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I can’t go beyond the LORD’s word, to do either good or bad from my own mind. I will say what the LORD says’? ¹⁴Now, behold, I go to my people. Come, I will inform you what this people shall do to your people in the latter days.” ¹⁵He took up his parable, and said, “Balaam the son of Beor says, the man whose eyes are open says; ¹⁶he says, who hears the words of God, knows the knowledge of the Most High, and who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down, and having his eyes open: ¹⁷I see him, but not now. I see him, but not near. A star will come out of Jacob. A scepter will rise out of Israel, and shall strike through the corners of Moab, and crush all the sons of Sheth. ¹⁸Edom shall be a possession. Seir, his enemy, also shall be a possession, while Israel does valiantly. ¹⁹Out of Jacob shall one have dominion, and shall destroy the remnant from the city.” ²⁰He looked at Amalek, and took up his parable, and said, “Amalek was the first of the nations, But his latter end shall come to destruction.” ²¹He looked at the Kenite, and took up his parable, and said, “Your dwelling place is strong. Your nest is set in the rock. ²²Nevertheless Kain shall be wasted, until Asshur carries you away captive.” ²³He took up his parable, and said, “Alas, who shall live when God does this? ²⁴But ships shall come from the coast of Kittim. They shall afflict Asshur, and shall afflict Eber. He also shall come to destruction.” ²⁵Balaam rose up, and went and returned to his place; and Balak also went his way.

25Israel stayed in Shittim; and the people began to play the prostitute with the daughters of Moab; ²for they called the people to the sacrifices of their gods. The people ate and bowed down to their gods. ³Israel joined himself to Baal Peor, and the LORD’s anger burned against Israel. ⁴The LORD said to Moses, “Take all the chiefs of the people, and hang them up to the LORD before the sun, that the fierce anger of the LORD may turn away from Israel.” ⁵Moses said to the judges of Israel, “Everyone kill his men who have joined themselves to Baal Peor.” ⁶Behold, one of the children of Israel came and brought to his brothers a Midianite woman in the sight of Moses, and in the sight of all the congregation of the children of Israel, while they were weeping at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ⁷When Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, saw it, he rose up from the middle of the congregation, and

took a spear in his hand. ⁸He went after the man of Israel into the pavilion, and thrust both of them through, the man of Israel, and the woman through her body. So the plague was stopped among the children of Israel. ⁹Those who died by the plague were twenty-four thousand. ¹⁰The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹¹“Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, has turned my wrath away from the children of Israel, in that he was jealous with my jealousy among them, so that I didn’t consume the children of Israel in my jealousy. ¹²Therefore say, ‘Behold, I give to him my covenant of peace. ¹³It shall be to him, and to his offspring after him, the covenant of an everlasting priesthood, because he was jealous for his God, and made atonement for the children of Israel.’” ¹⁴Now the name of the man of Israel that was slain, who was slain with the Midianite woman, was Zimri, the son of Salu, a prince of a fathers’ house among the Simeonites. ¹⁵The name of the Midianite woman who was slain was Cozbi, the daughter of Zur. He was head of the people of a fathers’ house in Midian. ¹⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁷“Harass the Midianites, and strike them; ¹⁸for they harassed you with their wives, wherein they have deceived you in the matter of Peor, and in the incident regarding Cozbi, the daughter of the prince of Midian, their sister, who was slain on the day of the plague in the matter of Peor.”

26After the plague, the LORD spoke to Moses and to Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, saying, ²“Take a census of all the congregation of the children of Israel, from twenty years old and upward, by their fathers’ houses, all who are able to go out to war in Israel.” ³Moses and Eleazar the priest spoke with them in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying, ⁴“Take a census, from twenty years old and upward, as the LORD commanded Moses and the children of Israel.” These are those who came out of the land of Egypt. ⁵Reuben, the firstborn of Israel; the sons of Reuben: of Hanoch, the family of the Hanochites; of Pallu, the family of the Palluites; ⁶of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites; of Carmi, the family of the Carmites. ⁷These are the families of the Reubenites; and those who were counted of them were forty-three thousand seven hundred thirty. ⁸The son of Pallu: Eliab. ⁹The sons of Eliab: Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. These are that Dathan and Abiram who were called by the congregation, who rebelled against Moses and against Aaron in the company of Korah when they rebelled against the LORD; ¹⁰and the earth opened its mouth, and swallowed them up together with Korah when that company died; at the time the fire devoured two hundred fifty men, and they became a sign. ¹¹Notwithstanding, the sons of Korah didn’t die. ¹²The sons of Simeon after their families: of Nemuel, the family of the Nemuelites; of Jamin, the family of the Jaminites; of Jachin, the family of the Jachinites; ¹³of Zerah, the family of the Zerahites; of Shaul, the family of

the Shaulites. ¹⁴These are the families of the Simeonites, twenty-two thousand two hundred. ¹⁵The sons of Gad after their families: of Zephon, the family of the Zephonites; of Haggi, the family of the Haggites; of Shuni, the family of the Shunites; ¹⁶of Ozni, the family of the Oznites; of Eri, the family of the Erites; ¹⁷of Arod, the family of the Arodites; of Areli, the family of the Arelites. ¹⁸These are the families of the sons of Gad according to those who were counted of them, forty thousand and five hundred. ¹⁹The sons of Judah: Er and Onan. Er and Onan died in the land of Canaan. ²⁰The sons of Judah after their families were: of Shelah, the family of the Shelanites; of Perez, the family of the Perezites; of Zerah, the family of the Zerahites. ²¹The sons of Perez were: of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites; of Hamul, the family of the Hamulites. ²²These are the families of Judah according to those who were counted of them, seventy-six thousand five hundred. ²³The sons of Issachar after their families: of Tola, the family of the Tolaites; of Puvah, the family of the Punites; ²⁴of Jashub, the family of the Jashubites; of Shimron, the family of the Shimronites. ²⁵These are the families of Issachar according to those who were counted of them, sixty-four thousand three hundred. ²⁶The sons of Zebulun after their families: of Sered, the family of the Seredites; of Elon, the family of the Elonites; of Jahleel, the family of the Jahleelites. ²⁷These are the families of the Zebulunites according to those who were counted of them, sixty thousand five hundred. ²⁸The sons of Joseph after their families: Manasseh and Ephraim. ²⁹The sons of Manasseh: of Machir, the family of the Machirites; and Machir became the father of Gilead; of Gilead, the family of the Gileadites. ³⁰These are the sons of Gilead: of Iezer, the family of the Iezerites; of Helek, the family of the Helekites; ³¹and Asriel, the family of the Asrielites; and Shechem, the family of the Shechemites; ³²and Shemida, the family of the Shemidaites; and Hephher, the family of the Hephherites. ³³Zelophehad the son of Hephher had no sons, but daughters: and the names of the daughters of Zelophehad were Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. ³⁴These are the families of Manasseh. Those who were counted of them were fifty-two thousand seven hundred. ³⁵These are the sons of Ephraim after their families: of Shuthelah, the family of the Shuthelahites; of Becher, the family of the Becherites; of Tahan, the family of the Tahanites. ³⁶These are the sons of Shuthelah: of Eran, the family of the Eranites. ³⁷These are the families of the sons of Ephraim according to those who were counted of them, thirty-two thousand five hundred. These are the sons of Joseph after their families. ³⁸The sons of Benjamin after their families: of Bela, the family of the Belaites; of Ashbel, the family of the Ashbelites; of Ahiram, the family of the Ahiramites; ³⁹of Shephupham, the family of the Shuphamites; of Hupham, the family of the Huphamites. ⁴⁰The sons of Bela were Ard and Naaman: the family of the Ardites; and of Naaman, the fam-

ily of the Naamites. ⁴¹These are the sons of Benjamin after their families; and those who were counted of them were forty-five thousand six hundred. ⁴²These are the sons of Dan after their families: of Shuham, the family of the Shuhamites. These are the families of Dan after their families. ⁴³All the families of the Shuhamites, according to those who were counted of them, were sixty-four thousand four hundred. ⁴⁴The sons of Asher after their families: of Imnah, the family of the Imnites; of Ishvi, the family of the Ishvites; of Beriah, the family of the Berites. ⁴⁵Of the sons of Beriah: of Heber, the family of the Heberites; of Malchiel, the family of the Malchielites. ⁴⁶The name of the daughter of Asher was Serah. ⁴⁷These are the families of the sons of Asher according to those who were counted of them, fifty-three thousand four hundred. ⁴⁸The sons of Naphtali after their families: of Jahzeel, the family of the Jahzeelites; of Guni, the family of the Gunites; ⁴⁹of Jezer, the family of the Jezerites; of Shillem, the family of the Shillemites. ⁵⁰These are the families of Naphtali according to their families; and those who were counted of them were forty-five thousand four hundred. ⁵¹These are those who were counted of the children of Israel, six hundred one thousand seven hundred thirty. ⁵²The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁵³“To these the land shall be divided for an inheritance according to the number of names. ⁵⁴To the more you shall give the more inheritance, and to the fewer you shall give the less inheritance. To everyone according to those who were counted of him shall his inheritance be given. ⁵⁵Notwithstanding, the land shall be divided by lot. According to the names of the tribes of their fathers they shall inherit. ⁵⁶According to the lot shall their inheritance be divided between the more and the fewer.” ⁵⁷These are those who were counted of the Levites after their families: of Gershon, the family of the Gershonites; of Kohath, the family of the Kohathites; of Merari, the family of the Merarites. ⁵⁸These are the families of Levi: the family of the Libnites, the family of the Hebronites, the family of the Mahlites, the family of the Mushites, and the family of the Korahites. Kohath became the father of Amram. ⁵⁹The name of Amram’s wife was Jochebed, the daughter of Levi, who was born to Levi in Egypt. She bore to Amram Aaron and Moses, and Miriam their sister. ⁶⁰To Aaron were born Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar. ⁶¹Nadab and Abihu died when they offered strange fire before the LORD. ⁶²Those who were counted of them were twenty-three thousand, every male from a month old and upward; for they were not counted among the children of Israel, because there was no inheritance given them among the children of Israel. ⁶³These are those who were counted by Moses and Eleazar the priest, who counted the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho. ⁶⁴But among these there was not a man of them who were counted by Moses and Aaron the priest, who counted the children of Israel in the wilderness of Sinai. ⁶⁵For the

LORD had said of them, “They shall surely die in the wilderness.” There was not a man left of them, except Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.

27Then the daughters of Zelophehad, the son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of Manasseh the son of Joseph came near. These are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. ²They stood before Moses, before Eleazar the priest, and before the princes and all the congregation, at the door of the Tent of Meeting, saying, ³“Our father died in the wilderness. He was not among the company of those who gathered themselves together against the LORD in the company of Korah, but he died in his own sin. He had no sons. ⁴Why should the name of our father be taken away from among his family, because he had no son? Give to us a possession among the brothers of our father.” ⁵Moses brought their cause before the LORD. ⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁷“The daughters of Zelophehad speak right. You shall surely give them a possession of an inheritance among their father’s brothers. You shall cause the inheritance of their father to pass to them. ⁸You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, ‘If a man dies, and has no son, then you shall cause his inheritance to pass to his daughter. ⁹If he has no daughter, then you shall give his inheritance to his brothers. ¹⁰If he has no brothers, then you shall give his inheritance to his father’s brothers. ¹¹If his father has no brothers, then you shall give his inheritance to his kinsman who is next to him of his family, and he shall possess it. This shall be a statute and ordinance for the children of Israel, as the LORD commanded Moses.’” ¹²The LORD said to Moses, “Go up into this mountain of Abarim, and see the land which I have given to the children of Israel. ¹³When you have seen it, you also shall be gathered to your people, as Aaron your brother was gathered; ¹⁴because in the strife of the congregation, you rebelled against my word in the wilderness of Zin, to honor me as holy at the waters before their eyes.” (These are the waters of Meribah of Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.) ¹⁵Moses spoke to the LORD, saying, ¹⁶“Let the LORD, the God of the spirits of all flesh, appoint a man over the congregation, ¹⁷who may go out before them, and who may come in before them, and who may lead them out, and who may bring them in, that the congregation of the LORD may not be as sheep which have no shepherd.” ¹⁸The LORD said to Moses, “Take Joshua the son of Nun, a man in whom is the Spirit, and lay your hand on him. ¹⁹Set him before Eleazar the priest, and before all the congregation; and commission him in their sight. ²⁰You shall give authority to him, that all the congregation of the children of Israel may obey. ²¹He shall stand before Eleazar the priest, who shall inquire for him by the judgment of the Urim before the LORD. At his word they shall go out, and at his word they shall come in,

both he and all the children of Israel with him, even all the congregation.”²² Moses did as the LORD commanded him. He took Joshua, and set him before Eleazar the priest and before all the congregation.²³ He laid his hands on him and commissioned him, as the LORD spoke by Moses.

28 The LORD spoke to Moses, saying,²⁴ “Command the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘See that you present my offering, my food for my offerings made by fire, as a pleasant aroma to me, in their due season.’³ You shall tell them, ‘This is the offering made by fire which you shall offer to the LORD: male lambs a year old without defect, two day by day, for a continual burnt offering.⁴ You shall offer the one lamb in the morning, and you shall offer the other lamb at evening,⁵ with one tenth of an ephah^{xxxvii} of fine flour for a meal offering, mixed with the fourth part of a hin^{xxxviii} of beaten oil.’⁶ It is a continual burnt offering which was ordained in Mount Sinai for a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD.⁷ Its drink offering shall be the fourth part of a hin^{xxxix} for each lamb. You shall pour out a drink offering of strong drink to the LORD in the holy place.⁸ The other lamb you shall offer at evening. As the meal offering of the morning, and as its drink offering, you shall offer it, an offering made by fire, for a pleasant aroma to the LORD.⁹ “On the Sabbath day, you shall offer two male lambs a year old without defect, and two tenths of an ephah^{xl} of fine flour for a meal offering mixed with oil, and its drink offering:¹⁰ this is the burnt offering of every Sabbath, in addition to the continual burnt offering and its drink offering.¹¹ “In the beginnings of your months, you shall offer a burnt offering to the LORD: two young bulls, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect,¹² and three tenths of an ephah^{xli} of fine flour for a meal offering mixed with oil, for each bull; and two tenth parts of fine flour for a meal offering mixed with oil, for the one ram;¹³ and one tenth part of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering to every lamb, as a burnt offering of a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD.¹⁴ Their drink offerings shall be half a hin of wine for a bull, the third part of a hin for the ram, and the fourth part of a hin for a lamb. This is the burnt offering of every month throughout the months of the year.¹⁵ Also, one male goat for a sin offering to the LORD shall be offered in addition to the continual burnt offering and its drink offering.¹⁶ “In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, is the LORD’s Passover.¹⁷ On the fifteenth day of this month shall be a feast. Unleavened bread shall be eaten for seven days.¹⁸ In the first day shall be a holy convocation. You

shall do no regular work,¹⁹ but you shall offer an offering made by fire, a burnt offering to the LORD: two young bulls, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old. They shall be without defect,²⁰ with their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil. You shall offer three tenths for a bull, and two tenths for the ram.²¹ You shall offer one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;²² and one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for you.²³ You shall offer these in addition to the burnt offering of the morning, which is for a continual burnt offering.²⁴ In this way you shall offer daily, for seven days, the food of the offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD. It shall be offered in addition to the continual burnt offering and its drink offering.²⁵ On the seventh day you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.²⁶ “Also in the day of the first fruits, when you offer a new meal offering to the LORD in your feast of weeks, you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work;²⁷ but you shall offer a burnt offering for a pleasant aroma to the LORD: two young bulls, one ram, seven male lambs a year old;²⁸ and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil, three tenths for each bull, two tenths for the one ram,²⁹ one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;³⁰ and one male goat, to make atonement for you.³¹ Besides the continual burnt offering and its meal offering, you shall offer them and their drink offerings. See that they are without defect.

29 “In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, you shall have a holy convocation; you shall do no regular work. It is a day of blowing of shofars^{xlii} or, trumpetsto you.² You shall offer a burnt offering for a pleasant aroma to the LORD: one young bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect;³ and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil: three tenths for the bull, two tenths for the ram,⁴ and one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;⁵ and one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for you;⁶ in addition to the burnt offering of the new moon with its meal offering, and the continual burnt offering with its meal offering, and their drink offerings, according to their ordinance, for a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD.⁷ “On the tenth day of this seventh month you shall have a holy convocation. You shall afflict your souls. You shall do no kind of work;⁸ but you shall offer a burnt offering to the LORD for a pleasant aroma: one young bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old, all without defect;⁹ and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil: three tenths for the bull, two tenths for the one ram,¹⁰ one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;¹¹ one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the sin offering of atonement, and the continual burnt offering, and its meal offering, and their drink offerings.¹² “On the fifteenth day of the seventh month you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.

^{xxxvii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxxviii}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

^{xxxix}One hin is about 6.5 liters, so 1/4 hin is about 1.6 liters or 1.7 quarts.

^{xli}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xlii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xlii}or, trumpets

You shall keep a feast to the LORD seven days. ¹³You shall offer a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to the LORD: thirteen young bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old, all without defect; ¹⁴and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil: three tenths for every bull of the thirteen bulls, two tenths for each ram of the two rams, ¹⁵and one tenth for every lamb of the fourteen lambs; ¹⁶and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, its meal offering, and its drink offering. ¹⁷“On the second day you shall offer twelve young bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ¹⁸and their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance; ¹⁹and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, with its meal offering and their drink offerings. ²⁰“On the third day: eleven bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ²¹and their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance; ²²and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, and its meal offering, and its drink offering. ²³“On the fourth day ten bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ²⁴their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance; ²⁵and one male goat for a sin offering; in addition to the continual burnt offering, its meal offering, and its drink offering. ²⁶“On the fifth day: nine bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ²⁷and their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance, ²⁸and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, and its meal offering, and its drink offering. ²⁹“On the sixth day: eight bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ³⁰and their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance, ³¹and one male goat for a sin offering; in addition to the continual burnt offering, its meal offering, and the drink offerings of it. ³²“On the seventh day: seven bulls, two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old without defect; ³³and their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and for the lambs, according to their number, after the ordinance, ³⁴and one male goat for a sin offering; in addition to the continual burnt offering, its meal offering, and its drink offering. ³⁵“On the eighth day you shall have a solemn assembly. You shall do no regular work; ³⁶but you shall offer a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, a pleasant aroma to the LORD: one bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect; ³⁷their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bull, for the ram, and for the lambs, shall be according to their

number, after the ordinance, ³⁸and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, with its meal offering, and its drink offering. ³⁹“You shall offer these to the LORD in your set feasts—in addition to your vows and your free will offerings—for your burnt offerings, your meal offerings, your drink offerings, and your peace offerings.” ⁴⁰Moses told the children of Israel according to all that the LORD commanded Moses.

30 Moses spoke to the heads of the tribes of the children of Israel, saying, “This is the thing which the LORD has commanded. ²When a man vows a vow to the LORD, or swears an oath to bind his soul with a bond, he shall not break his word. He shall do according to all that proceeds out of his mouth. ³“Also, when a woman vows a vow to the LORD and binds herself by a pledge, being in her father’s house, in her youth, ⁴and her father hears her vow and her pledge with which she has bound her soul, and her father says nothing to her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge with which she has bound her soul shall stand. ⁵But if her father forbids her in the day that he hears, none of her vows or of her pledges with which she has bound her soul, shall stand. The LORD will forgive her, because her father has forbidden her. ⁶“If she has a husband, while her vows are on her, or the rash utterance of her lips with which she has bound her soul, ⁷and her husband hears it, and says nothing to her in the day that he hears it; then her vows shall stand, and her pledges with which she has bound her soul shall stand. ⁸But if her husband forbids her in the day that he hears it, then he makes void her vow which is on her and the rash utterance of her lips, with which she has bound her soul. The LORD will forgive her. ⁹“But the vow of a widow, or of her who is divorced, everything with which she has bound her soul shall stand against her. ¹⁰“If she vowed in her husband’s house or bound her soul by a bond with an oath, ¹¹and her husband heard it, and held his peace at her and didn’t disallow her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge with which she bound her soul shall stand. ¹²But if her husband made them null and void in the day that he heard them, then whatever proceeded out of her lips concerning her vows, or concerning the bond of her soul, shall not stand. Her husband has made them void. The LORD will forgive her. ¹³Every vow, and every binding oath to afflict the soul, her husband may establish it, or her husband may make it void. ¹⁴But if her husband says nothing to her from day to day, then he establishes all her vows or all her pledges which are on her. He has established them, because he said nothing to her in the day that he heard them. ¹⁵But if he makes them null and void after he has heard them, then he shall bear her iniquity.” ¹⁶These are the statutes which the LORD commanded Moses, between a man and his wife, between a father and his daughter, being in her youth, in her father’s house.

³¹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²“Avenge the children of Israel on the Midianites. Afterward you shall be gathered to your people.” ³Moses spoke to the people, saying, “Arm men from among you for war, that they may go against Midian, to execute the LORD’s vengeance on Midian. ⁴You shall send one thousand out of every tribe, throughout all the tribes of Israel, to the war.” ⁵So there were delivered, out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand from every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war. ⁶Moses sent them, one thousand of every tribe, to the war with Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the vessels of the sanctuary and the shofars ^{xliii} or, trumpets for the alarm in his hand. ⁷They fought against Midian, as the LORD commanded Moses. They killed every male. ⁸They killed the kings of Midian with the rest of their slain: Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the five kings of Midian. They also killed Balaam the son of Beor with the sword. ⁹The children of Israel took the women of Midian captive with their little ones; and all their livestock, all their flocks, and all their goods, they took as plunder. ¹⁰All their cities in the places in which they lived, and all their encampments, they burned with fire. ¹¹They took all the captives, and all the plunder, both of man and of animal. ¹²They brought the captives with the prey and the plunder, to Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of the children of Israel, to the camp at the plains of Moab, which are by the Jordan at Jericho. ¹³Moses and Eleazar the priest, with all the princes of the congregation, went out to meet them outside of the camp. ¹⁴Moses was angry with the officers of the army, the captains of thousands and the captains of hundreds, who came from the service of the war. ¹⁵Moses said to them, “Have you saved all the women alive? ¹⁶Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and so the plague was among the congregation of the LORD. ¹⁷Now therefore kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman who has known man by lying with him. ¹⁸But all the girls, who have not known man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves. ¹⁹“Encamp outside of the camp for seven days. Whoever has killed any person, and whoever has touched any slain, purify yourselves on the third day and on the seventh day, you and your captives. ²⁰You shall purify every garment, and all that is made of skin, and all work of goats’ hair, and all things made of wood.” ²¹Eleazar the priest said to the men of war who went to the battle, “This is the statute of the law which the LORD has commanded Moses. ²²However the gold, and the silver, the bronze, the iron, the tin, and the lead, ²³everything that may withstand the fire, you shall make to go through the fire, and it shall be clean; nevertheless it shall be purified with the water for impurity. All that doesn’t withstand the fire you

shall make to go through the water. ²⁴You shall wash your clothes on the seventh day, and you shall be clean. Afterward you shall come into the camp.” ²⁵The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²⁶“Count the plunder that was taken, both of man and of animal, you, and Eleazar the priest, and the heads of the fathers’ households of the congregation; ²⁷and divide the plunder into two parts: between the men skilled in war, who went out to battle, and all the congregation. ²⁸Levy a tribute to the LORD of the men of war who went out to battle: one soul of five hundred; of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks. ²⁹Take it from their half, and give it to Eleazar the priest, for the LORD’s wave offering. ³⁰Of the children of Israel’s half, you shall take one drawn out of every fifty, of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks, of all the livestock, and give them to the Levites, who perform the duty of the LORD’s tabernacle.” ³¹Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD commanded Moses. ³²Now the plunder, over and above the booty which the men of war took, was six hundred seventy-five thousand sheep, ³³seventy-two thousand head of cattle, ³⁴sixty-one thousand donkeys, ³⁵and thirty-two thousand persons in all, of the women who had not known man by lying with him. ³⁶The half, which was the portion of those who went out to war, was in number three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep; ³⁷and the LORD’s tribute of the sheep was six hundred seventy-five. ³⁸The cattle were thirty-six thousand, of which the LORD’s tribute was seventy-two. ³⁹The donkeys were thirty thousand five hundred, of which the LORD’s tribute was sixty-one. ⁴⁰The persons were sixteen thousand, of whom the LORD’s tribute was thirty-two persons. ⁴¹Moses gave the tribute, which was the LORD’s wave offering, to Eleazar the priest, as the LORD commanded Moses. ⁴²Of the children of Israel’s half, which Moses divided off from the men who fought ⁴³(now the congregation’s half was three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep, ⁴⁴thirty-six thousand head of cattle, ⁴⁵thirty thousand five hundred donkeys, ⁴⁶and sixteen thousand persons), ⁴⁷even of the children of Israel’s half, Moses took one drawn out of every fifty, both of man and of animal, and gave them to the Levites, who performed the duty of the LORD’s tabernacle, as the LORD commanded Moses. ⁴⁸The officers who were over the thousands of the army, the captains of thousands, and the captains of hundreds, came near to Moses. ⁴⁹They said to Moses, “Your servants have taken the sum of the men of war who are under our command, and there lacks not one man of us. ⁵⁰We have brought the LORD’s offering, what every man found: gold ornaments, armlets, bracelets, signet rings, earrings, and necklaces, to make atonement for our souls before the LORD.” ⁵¹Moses and Eleazar the priest took their gold, even all worked jewels. ⁵²All the gold of the wave offering that they offered up to the LORD, of the captains of thousands, and of the

^{xliii}or, trumpets

captains of hundreds, was sixteen thousand seven hundred fifty shekels. ^{xliv} ⁵³The men of war had taken booty, every man for himself. ⁵⁴Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and brought it into the Tent of Meeting for a memorial for the children of Israel before the LORD.

32Now the children of Reuben and the children of Gad had a very great multitude of livestock. They saw the land of Jazer, and the land of Gilead. Behold, the place was a place for livestock. ²Then the children of Gad and the children of Reuben came and spoke to Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to the princes of the congregation, saying, ³“Ataroth, Dibon, Jazer, Nimrah, Heshbon, Elealeh, Sebam, Nebo, and Beon, ⁴the land which The LORD struck before the congregation of Israel, is a land for livestock; and your servants have livestock.” ⁵They said, “If we have found favor in your sight, let this land be given to your servants for a possession. Don’t bring us over the Jordan.” ⁶Moses said to the children of Gad, and to the children of Reuben, “Shall your brothers go to war while you sit here? ⁷Why do you discourage the heart of the children of Israel from going over into the land which the LORD has given them? ⁸Your fathers did so when I sent them from Kadesh Barnea to see the land. ⁹For when they went up to the valley of Eshcol, and saw the land, they discouraged the heart of the children of Israel, that they should not go into the land which the LORD had given them. ¹⁰The LORD’s anger burned in that day, and he swore, saying, ¹¹‘Surely none of the men who came up out of Egypt, from twenty years old and upward, shall see the land which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob; because they have not wholly followed me, ¹²except Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite, and Joshua the son of Nun, because they have followed the LORD completely.’ ¹³The LORD’s anger burned against Israel, and he made them wander back and forth in the wilderness forty years, until all the generation who had done evil in the LORD’s sight was consumed. ¹⁴‘Behold, you have risen up in your fathers’ place, an increase of sinful men, to increase the fierce anger of the LORD toward Israel. ¹⁵For if you turn away from after him, he will yet again leave them in the wilderness; and you will destroy all these people.’ ¹⁶They came near to him, and said, “We will build sheepfolds here for our livestock, and cities for our little ones; ¹⁷but we ourselves will be ready armed to go before the children of Israel, until we have brought them to their place. Our little ones shall dwell in the fortified cities because of the inhabitants of the land. ¹⁸We will not return to our houses until the children of Israel have all received their inheritance. ¹⁹For we will not inherit with them on the other side of the Jordan and beyond, because our inheritance has come to us on

this side of the Jordan eastward.” ²⁰Moses said to them: “If you will do this thing, if you will arm yourselves to go before the LORD to the war, ²¹and every one of your armed men will pass over the Jordan before the LORD until he has driven out his enemies from before him, ²²and the land is subdued before the LORD; then afterward you shall return, and be clear of obligation to the LORD and to Israel. Then this land shall be your possession before the LORD. ²³“But if you will not do so, behold, you have sinned against the LORD; and be sure your sin will find you out. ²⁴Build cities for your little ones, and folds for your sheep; and do that which has proceeded out of your mouth.” ²⁵The children of Gad and the children of Reuben spoke to Moses, saying, “Your servants will do as my lord commands. ²⁶Our little ones, our wives, our flocks, and all our livestock shall be there in the cities of Gilead; ²⁷but your servants will pass over, every man who is armed for war, before the LORD to battle, as my lord says.” ²⁸So Moses commanded concerning them to Eleazar the priest, and to Joshua the son of Nun, and to the heads of the fathers’ households of the tribes of the children of Israel. ²⁹Moses said to them, “If the children of Gad and the children of Reuben will pass with you over the Jordan, every man who is armed to battle before the LORD, and the land is subdued before you, then you shall give them the land of Gilead for a possession; ³⁰but if they will not pass over with you armed, they shall have possessions among you in the land of Canaan.” ³¹The children of Gad and the children of Reuben answered, saying, “As the LORD has said to your servants, so will we do. ³²We will pass over armed before the LORD into the land of Canaan, and the possession of our inheritance shall remain with us beyond the Jordan.” ³³Moses gave to them, even to the children of Gad, and to the children of Reuben, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan; the land, according to its cities and borders, even the cities of the surrounding land. ³⁴The children of Gad built Dibon, Ataroth, Aroer, ³⁵Atroth-shophan, Jazer, Jogbehah, ³⁶Beth Nimrah, and Beth Haran: fortified cities and folds for sheep. ³⁷The children of Reuben built Heshbon, Elealeh, Kiriathaim, ³⁸Nebo, and Baal Meon, (their names being changed), and Sibmah. They gave other names to the cities which they built. ³⁹The children of Machir the son of Manasseh went to Gilead, took it, and dispossessed the Amorites who were therein. ⁴⁰Moses gave Gilead to Machir the son of Manasseh; and he lived therein. ⁴¹Jair the son of Manasseh went and took its villages, and called them Havvoth Jair. ⁴²Nobah went and took Kenath and its villages, and called it Nobah, after his own name.

33These are the journeys of the children of Israel, when they went out of the land of Egypt by their armies under the hand of Moses and Aaron. ²Moses wrote the

^{xliv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 16,750 shekels is about 167.5 kilograms or about 368.5 pounds.

starting points of their journeys by the commandment of the LORD. These are their journeys according to their starting points. ³They traveled from Rameses in the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month; on the next day after the Passover, the children of Israel went out with a high hand in the sight of all the Egyptians, ⁴while the Egyptians were burying all their firstborn, whom the LORD had struck among them. The LORD also executed judgments on their gods. ⁵The children of Israel traveled from Rameses, and encamped in Succoth. ⁶They traveled from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, which is in the edge of the wilderness. ⁷They traveled from Etham, and turned back to Pihahiroth, which is before Baal Zephon, and they encamped before Migdol. ⁸They traveled from before Hahiroth, and crossed through the middle of the sea into the wilderness. They went three days' journey in the wilderness of Etham, and encamped in Marah. ⁹They traveled from Marah, and came to Elim. In Elim, there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees, and they encamped there. ¹⁰They traveled from Elim, and encamped by the Sea of Suf. ¹¹They traveled from the Sea of Suf, and encamped in the wilderness of Sin. ¹²They traveled from the wilderness of Sin, and encamped in Dophkah. ¹³They traveled from Dophkah, and encamped in Alush. ¹⁴They traveled from Alush, and encamped in Rephidim, where there was no water for the people to drink. ¹⁵They traveled from Rephidim, and encamped in the wilderness of Sinai. ¹⁶They traveled from the wilderness of Sinai, and encamped in Kibroth Hattaavah. ¹⁷They traveled from Kibroth Hattaavah, and encamped in Hazeroth. ¹⁸They traveled from Hazeroth, and encamped in Rithmah. ¹⁹They traveled from Rithmah, and encamped in Rimmon Perez. ²⁰They traveled from Rimmon Perez, and encamped in Libnah. ²¹They traveled from Libnah, and encamped in Rissah. ²²They traveled from Rissah, and encamped in Kehelathah. ²³They traveled from Kehelathah, and encamped in Mount Shepher. ²⁴They traveled from Mount Shepher, and encamped in Haradah. ²⁵They traveled from Haradah, and encamped in Makheloth. ²⁶They traveled from Makheloth, and encamped in Tahath. ²⁷They traveled from Tahath, and encamped in Terah. ²⁸They traveled from Terah, and encamped in Mithkah. ²⁹They traveled from Mithkah, and encamped in Hashmonah. ³⁰They traveled from Hashmonah, and encamped in Moseroth. ³¹They traveled from Moseroth, and encamped in Bene Jaakan. ³²They traveled from Bene Jaakan, and encamped in Hor Haggidgad. ³³They traveled from Hor Haggidgad, and encamped in Jotbathah. ³⁴They traveled from Jotbathah, and encamped in Abronah. ³⁵They traveled from Abronah, and encamped in Ezion Geber. ³⁶They traveled from Ezion Geber, and encamped at Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin. ³⁷They traveled from Kadesh, and encamped in Mount Hor, in the edge of the land of Edom. ³⁸Aaron the priest went up

into Mount Hor at the commandment of the LORD and died there, in the fortieth year after the children of Israel had come out of the land of Egypt, in the fifth month, on the first day of the month. ³⁹Aaron was one hundred twenty-three years old when he died in Mount Hor. ⁴⁰The Canaanite king of Arad, who lived in the South in the land of Canaan, heard of the coming of the children of Israel. ⁴¹They traveled from Mount Hor, and encamped in Zalmonah. ⁴²They traveled from Zalmonah, and encamped in Punon. ⁴³They traveled from Punon, and encamped in Oboth. ⁴⁴They traveled from Oboth, and encamped in Iye Abarim, in the border of Moab. ⁴⁵They traveled from Iyim, and encamped in Dibon Gad. ⁴⁶They traveled from Dibon Gad, and encamped in Almon Diblathaim. ⁴⁷They traveled from Almon Diblathaim, and encamped in the mountains of Abarim, before Nebo. ⁴⁸They traveled from the mountains of Abarim, and encamped in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho. ⁴⁹They encamped by the Jordan, from Beth Jeshimoth even to Abel Shittim in the plains of Moab. ⁵⁰The LORD spoke to Moses in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying, ⁵¹Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, "When you pass over the Jordan into the land of Canaan, ⁵²then you shall drive out all the inhabitants of the land from before you, destroy all their stone idols, destroy all their molten images, and demolish all their high places. ⁵³You shall take possession of the land, and dwell therein; for I have given the land to you to possess it. ⁵⁴You shall inherit the land by lot according to your families; to the larger groups you shall give a larger inheritance, and to the smaller you shall give a smaller inheritance. Wherever the lot falls to any man, that shall be his. You shall inherit according to the tribes of your fathers. ⁵⁵"But if you do not drive out the inhabitants of the land from before you, then those you let remain of them will be like pricks in your eyes and thorns in your sides. They will harass you in the land in which you dwell. ⁵⁶It shall happen that as I thought to do to them, so I will do to you."

34The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ²"Command the children of Israel, and tell them, 'When you come into the land of Canaan (this is the land that shall fall to you for an inheritance, even the land of Canaan according to its borders), ³then your south quarter shall be from the wilderness of Zin along by the side of Edom, and your south border shall be from the end of the Salt Sea eastward. ⁴Your border shall turn about southward of the ascent of Akrabbim, and pass along to Zin; and it shall pass southward of Kadesh Barnea; and it shall go from there to Hazar Addar, and pass along to Azmon. ⁵The border shall turn about from Azmon to the brook of Egypt, and it shall end at the sea. ⁶"For the western border, you shall have the great sea and its border. This shall be your west border. ⁷"This shall be your north border: from the

great sea you shall mark out for yourselves Mount Hor. ⁸From Mount Hor you shall mark out to the entrance of Hamath; and the border shall pass by Zedad. ⁹Then the border shall go to Ziphron, and it shall end at Hazar Enan. This shall be your north border. ¹⁰“You shall mark out your east border from Hazar Enan to Shepham. ¹¹The border shall go down from Shepham to Riblah, on the east side of Ain. The border shall go down, and shall reach to the side of the sea of Chinnereth eastward. ¹²The border shall go down to the Jordan, and end at the Salt Sea. This shall be your land according to its borders around it.” ¹³Moses commanded the children of Israel, saying, “This is the land which you shall inherit by lot, which the LORD has commanded to give to the nine tribes, and to the half-tribe; ¹⁴for the tribe of the children of Reuben according to their fathers’ houses, the tribe of the children of Gad according to their fathers’ houses, and the half-tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance. ¹⁵The two tribes and the half-tribe have received their inheritance beyond the Jordan at Jericho eastward, toward the sunrise.” ¹⁶The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁷“These are the names of the men who shall divide the land to you for inheritance: Eleazar the priest, and Joshua the son of Nun. ¹⁸You shall take one prince of every tribe, to divide the land for inheritance. ¹⁹These are the names of the men: Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of Jephunneh. ²⁰Of the tribe of the children of Simeon, Shemuel the son of Ammihud. ²¹Of the tribe of Benjamin, Elidad the son of Chislon. ²²Of the tribe of the children of Dan a prince, Bukki the son of Jogli. ²³Of the children of Joseph: of the tribe of the children of Manasseh a prince, Hanniel the son of Ephod. ²⁴Of the tribe of the children of Ephraim a prince, Kemuel the son of Shiphtan. ²⁵Of the tribe of the children of Zebulun a prince, Elizaphan the son of Parnach. ²⁶Of the tribe of the children of Issachar a prince, Paltiel the son of Azzan. ²⁷Of the tribe of the children of Asher a prince, Ahihud the son of Shelomi. ²⁸Of the tribe of the children of Naphtali a prince, Pedahel the son of Ammihud.” ²⁹These are they whom the LORD commanded to divide the inheritance to the children of Israel in the land of Canaan.

35The LORD spoke to Moses in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying, ²“Command the children of Israel to give to the Levites cities to dwell in out of their inheritance. You shall give pasture lands for the cities around them to the Levites. ³They shall have the cities to dwell in. Their pasture lands shall be for their livestock, and for their possessions, and for all their animals. ⁴“The pasture lands of the cities, which you shall give to the Levites, shall be from the wall of the city and outward one thousand cubits ^{xlv} around it. ⁵You shall measure outside

of the city for the east side two thousand cubits, and for the south side two thousand cubits, and for the west side two thousand cubits, and for the north side two thousand cubits, the city being in the middle. This shall be the pasture lands of their cities. ⁶“The cities which you shall give to the Levites, they shall be the six cities of refuge, which you shall give for the man slayer to flee to. Besides them you shall give forty-two cities. ⁷All the cities which you shall give to the Levites shall be forty-eight cities together with their pasture lands. ⁸Concerning the cities which you shall give of the possession of the children of Israel, from the many you shall take many, and from the few you shall take few. Everyone according to his inheritance which he inherits shall give some of his cities to the Levites.” ⁹The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ¹⁰“Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘When you pass over the Jordan into the land of Canaan, ¹¹then you shall appoint for yourselves cities to be cities of refuge for you, that the man slayer who kills any person unwittingly may flee there. ¹²The cities shall be for your refuge from the avenger, that the man slayer not die until he stands before the congregation for judgment. ¹³The cities which you shall give shall be for you six cities of refuge. ¹⁴You shall give three cities beyond the Jordan, and you shall give three cities in the land of Canaan. They shall be cities of refuge. ¹⁵These six cities shall be refuge for the children of Israel, for the stranger, and for the foreigner living among them, that everyone who kills any person unwittingly may flee there. ¹⁶“But if he struck him with an instrument of iron, so that he died, he is a murderer. The murderer shall surely be put to death. ¹⁷If he struck him with a stone in the hand, by which a man may die, and he died, he is a murderer. The murderer shall surely be put to death. ¹⁸Or if he struck him with a weapon of wood in the hand, by which a man may die, and he died, he is a murderer. The murderer shall surely be put to death. ¹⁹The avenger of blood shall himself put the murderer to death. When he meets him, he shall put him to death. ²⁰If he shoved him out of hatred, or hurled something at him while lying in wait, so that he died, ²¹or in hostility struck him with his hand, so that he died, he who struck him shall surely be put to death. He is a murderer. The avenger of blood shall put the murderer to death when he meets him. ²²“But if he shoved him suddenly without hostility, or hurled on him anything without lying in wait, ²³or with any stone, by which a man may die, not seeing him, and cast it on him so that he died, and he was not his enemy and not seeking his harm, ²⁴then the congregation shall judge between the striker and the avenger of blood according to these ordinances. ²⁵The congregation shall deliver the man slayer out of the hand of the avenger of blood, and the congregation shall restore him to his city of refuge, where he had fled. He shall dwell therein until the death of the high priest, who was anointed with the holy oil. ²⁶“But if the

^{xlv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

man slayer shall at any time go beyond the border of his city of refuge where he flees, ²⁷and the avenger of blood finds him outside of the border of his city of refuge, and the avenger of blood kills the man slayer, he shall not be guilty of blood, ²⁸because he should have remained in his city of refuge until the death of the high priest. But after the death of the high priest, the man slayer shall return into the land of his possession. ²⁹“These things shall be for a statute and ordinance to you throughout your generations in all your dwellings. ³⁰“Whoever kills any person, the murderer shall be slain based on the testimony of witnesses; but one witness shall not testify alone against any person so that he dies. ³¹“Moreover you shall take no ransom for the life of a murderer who is guilty of death. He shall surely be put to death. ³²“You shall take no ransom for him who has fled to his city of refuge, that he may come again to dwell in the land before the death of the priest. ³³“So you shall not pollute the land where you live; for blood pollutes the land. No atonement can be made for the land for the blood that is shed in it, but by the blood of him who shed it. ³⁴You shall not defile the land which you inhabit, where I dwell; for I, the LORD, dwell among the children of Israel.”

36The heads of the fathers' households of the family of the children of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of the sons of Joseph, came near and spoke before Moses and before the princes, the heads of the fathers' households of the children of Israel. ²They said, “The LORD commanded my lord to give the land for inheritance by lot to the children of Israel. My lord was commanded by the LORD to give the inheritance of Zelophehad our brother to his daughters. ³If they are married to any of the sons of the other tribes of the children of Israel, then their inheritance will be taken away from the inheritance of our fathers, and will be added to the inheritance of the tribe to which they shall belong. So it will be taken away from the lot of our inheritance. ⁴When the jubilee of the children of Israel comes, then their inheritance will be added to the inheritance of the tribe to which they shall belong. So their inheritance will be taken away from the inheritance of the tribe of our fathers.” ⁵Moses commanded the children of Israel according to the LORD's word, saying, “The tribe of the sons of Joseph speak what is right. ⁶This is the thing which the LORD commands concerning the daughters of Zelophehad, saying, ‘Let them be married to whom they think best, only they shall marry into the family of the tribe of their father. ⁷So shall no inheritance of the children of Israel move from tribe to tribe; for the children of Israel shall all keep the inheritance of the tribe of his fathers. ⁸Every daughter who possesses an inheritance in any tribe of the children of Israel shall be wife to one of the family of the tribe of her father, that the children of Israel may each possess the inheritance of

his fathers. ⁹So shall no inheritance move from one tribe to another tribe; for the tribes of the children of Israel shall each keep his own inheritance.” ¹⁰The daughters of Zelophehad did as the LORD commanded Moses: ¹¹for Mahlah, Tirzah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad, were married to their father's brothers' sons. ¹²They were married into the families of the sons of Manasseh the son of Joseph. Their inheritance remained in the tribe of the family of their father. ¹³These are the commandments and the ordinances which the LORD commanded by Moses to the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.

Deuteronomy

¹These are the words which Moses spoke to all Israel beyond the Jordan in the wilderness, in the Arabah opposite Suf, between Paran, Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth, and Dizahab. ²It is eleven days' journey from Horeb by the way of Mount Seir to Kadesh Barnea. ³In the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first day of the month, Moses spoke to the children of Israel according to all that the LORD ⁱ had given him in commandment to them, ⁴after he had struck Sihon the king of the Amorites who lived in Heshbon, and Og the king of Bashan who lived in Ashtaroth, at Edrei. ⁵Beyond the Jordan, in the land of Moab, Moses began to declare this law, saying, ⁶"The LORD our God ⁱⁱ spoke to us in Horeb, saying, 'You have lived long enough at this mountain. ⁷Turn, and take your journey, and go to the hill country of the Amorites and to all the places near there: in the Arabah, in the hill country, in the lowland, in the South, by the seashore, in the land of the Canaanites, and in Lebanon as far as the great river, the river Euphrates. ⁸Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I have set the land before you. Go in and possess the land which the LORD swore to your fathers—to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob—to give to them and to their offspring ^{iv} after them.'" ⁹I spoke to you at that time, saying, "I am not able to bear you myself alone. ¹⁰The LORD your God has multiplied you, and behold, you are today as the stars of the sky for multitude. ¹¹May the LORD, the God of your fathers, make you a thousand times as many as you are and bless you, as he has promised you! ¹²How can I myself alone bear your problems, your burdens, and your strife? ¹³Take wise men of understanding who are respected among your tribes, and I will make them heads over you." ¹⁴You answered me, and said, "The thing which you have spoken is good to do." ¹⁵So I took the heads of your tribes, wise and respected men, and made them heads over you, captains of thousands, captains of hundreds, captains of fifties, captains of tens, and officers, according to your tribes. ¹⁶I commanded your judges at that time, saying, "Hear cases

between your brothers and judge righteously between a man and his brother, and the foreigner who is living with him. ¹⁷You shall not show partiality in judgment; you shall hear the small and the great alike. You shall not be afraid of the face of man, for the judgment is God's. The case that is too hard for you, you shall bring to me, and I will hear it." ¹⁸I commanded you at that time all the things which you should do. ¹⁹We traveled from Horeb and went through all that great and terrible wilderness which you saw, by the way to the hill country of the Amorites, as the LORD our God commanded us; and we came to Kadesh Barnea. ²⁰I said to you, "You have come to the hill country of the Amorites, which the LORD our God gives to us. ²¹Behold, the LORD your God has set the land before you. Go up, take possession, as the LORD the God of your fathers has spoken to you. Don't be afraid, neither be dismayed." ²²You came near to me, everyone of you, and said, "Let's send men before us, that they may search the land for us, and bring back to us word of the way by which we must go up, and the cities to which we shall come." ²³The thing pleased me well. I took twelve of your men, one man for every tribe. ²⁴They turned and went up into the hill country, and came to the valley of Eshcol, and spied it out. ²⁵They took some of the fruit of the land in their hands and brought it down to us, and brought us word again, and said, "It is a good land which the LORD our God gives to us." ²⁶Yet you wouldn't go up, but rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God. ²⁷You murmured in your tents, and said, "Because the LORD hated us, he has brought us out of the land of Egypt, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites to destroy us. ²⁸Where are we going up? Our brothers have made our heart melt, saying, 'The people are greater and taller than we. The cities are great and fortified up to the sky. Moreover we have seen the sons of the Anakim there!'" ²⁹Then I said to you, "Don't be terrified. Don't be afraid of them. ³⁰The LORD your God, who goes before you, he will fight for you, according to all that he did for you in Egypt before your eyes, ³¹and in the wilderness where you have seen how that the LORD your God carried you, as a man carries his son, in all the way that you went, until you came to this place." ³²Yet in this thing you didn't believe the LORD your God, ³³who went before you on the way,

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim".

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}or, seed

to seek out a place for you to pitch your tents in: in fire by night, to show you by what way you should go, and in the cloud by day. ³⁴The LORD heard the voice of your words and was angry, and swore, saying, ³⁵"Surely not one of these men of this evil generation shall see the good land which I swore to give to your fathers, ³⁶except Caleb the son of Jephunneh. He shall see it. I will give the land that he has trodden on to him and to his children, because he has wholly followed the LORD." ³⁷Also the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, saying, "You also shall not go in there. ³⁸Joshua the son of Nun, who stands before you, shall go in there. Encourage him, for he shall cause Israel to inherit it. ³⁹Moreover your little ones, whom you said would be captured or killed, your children, who today have no knowledge of good or evil, shall go in there. I will give it to them, and they shall possess it. ⁴⁰But as for you, turn, and take your journey into the wilderness by the way to the Sea of Suf." ⁴¹Then you answered and said to me, "We have sinned against the LORD. We will go up and fight, according to all that the LORD our God commanded us." Every man of you put on his weapons of war, and presumed to go up into the hill country. ⁴²The LORD said to me, "Tell them, 'Don't go up and don't fight; for I am not among you, lest you be struck before your enemies.'" ⁴³So I spoke to you, and you didn't listen; but you rebelled against the commandment of the LORD, and were presumptuous, and went up into the hill country. ⁴⁴The Amorites, who lived in that hill country, came out against you and chased you as bees do, and beat you down in Seir, even to Hormah. ⁴⁵You returned and wept before the LORD, but the LORD didn't listen to your voice, nor turn his ear to you. ⁴⁶So you stayed in Kadesh many days, according to the days that you remained.

²Then we turned, and took our journey into the wilderness by the way to the Sea of Suf, as the LORD spoke to me; and we encircled Mount Seir many days. ²The LORD spoke to me, saying, ³"You have encircled this mountain long enough. Turn northward. ⁴Command the people, saying, 'You are to pass through the border of your brothers, the children of Esau, who dwell in Seir; and they will be afraid of you. Therefore be careful. ⁵Don't contend with them; for I will not give you any of their land, no, not so much as for the sole of the foot to tread on, because I have given Mount Seir to Esau for a possession. ⁶You shall purchase food from them for money, that you may eat. You shall also buy water from them for money, that you may drink.'" ⁷For the LORD your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has known your walking through this great wilderness. These forty years, the LORD your God has been with you. You have lacked nothing. ⁸So we passed by from our brothers, the children of Esau, who dwell in Seir, from the way of the Arabah from Elath and from Ezion Geber. We turned and passed

by the way of the wilderness of Moab. ⁹The LORD said to me, "Don't bother Moab, neither contend with them in battle; for I will not give you any of his land for a possession, because I have given Ar to the children of Lot for a possession." ¹⁰(The Emim lived there before, a great and numerous people, and tall as the Anakim. ¹¹These also are considered to be Rephaim, as the Anakim; but the Moabites call them Emim. ¹²The Horites also lived in Seir in the past, but the children of Esau succeeded them. They destroyed them from before them, and lived in their place, as Israel did to the land of his possession, which the LORD gave to them.) ¹³"Now rise up and cross over the brook Zered." We went over the brook Zered. ¹⁴The days in which we came from Kadesh Barnea until we had come over the brook Zered were thirty-eight years, until all the generation of the men of war were consumed from the middle of the camp, as the LORD swore to them. ¹⁵Moreover the LORD's hand was against them, to destroy them from the middle of the camp, until they were consumed. ¹⁶So, when all the men of war were consumed and dead from among the people, ¹⁷the LORD spoke to me, saying, ¹⁸"You are to pass over Ar, the border of Moab, today. ¹⁹When you come near the border of the children of Ammon, don't bother them, nor contend with them; for I will not give you any of the land of the children of Ammon for a possession, because I have given it to the children of Lot for a possession." ²⁰(That also is considered a land of Rephaim. Rephaim lived there in the past, but the Ammonites call them Zamzummim, ²¹a great people, many, and tall, as the Anakim; but the LORD destroyed them from before Israel, and they succeeded them, and lived in their place, ²²as he did for the children of Esau who dwell in Seir, when he destroyed the Horites from before them; and they succeeded them, and lived in their place even to this day. ²³Then the Avvim, who lived in villages as far as Gaza: the Caphtorim, who came out of Caphtor, destroyed them and lived in their place.) ²⁴"Rise up, take your journey, and pass over the valley of the Arnon. Behold, I have given into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land; begin to possess it, and contend with him in battle. ²⁵Today I will begin to put the dread of you and the fear of you on the peoples who are under the whole sky, who shall hear the report of you, and shall tremble and be in anguish because of you." ²⁶I sent messengers out of the wilderness of Kedemoth to Sihon king of Heshbon with words of peace, saying, ²⁷"Let me pass through your land. I will go along by the highway. I will turn neither to the right hand nor to the left. ²⁸You shall sell me food for money, that I may eat; and give me water for money, that I may drink. Just let me pass through on my feet, ²⁹as the children of Esau who dwell in Seir, and the Moabites who dwell in Ar, did to me, until I pass over the Jordan into the land which the LORD our God gives us." ³⁰But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us

pass by him, for the LORD your God hardened his spirit and made his heart obstinate, that he might deliver him into your hand, as it is today. ³¹The LORD said to me, “Behold, I have begun to deliver up Sihon and his land before you. Begin to possess, that you may inherit his land.” ³²Then Sihon came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Jahaz. ³³The LORD our God delivered him up before us; and we struck him, his sons, and all his people. ³⁴We took all his cities at that time, and utterly destroyed every inhabited city, with the women and the little ones. We left no one remaining. ³⁵Only the livestock we took for plunder for ourselves, with the plunder of the cities which we had taken. ³⁶From Aroer, which is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the valley, even to Gilead, there was not a city too high for us. The LORD our God delivered up all before us. ³⁷Only to the land of the children of Ammon you didn’t come near: all the banks of the river Jabbok, and the cities of the hill country, and wherever the LORD our God forbade us.

3Then we turned, and went up the way to Bashan. Og the king of Bashan came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei. ²The LORD said to me, “Don’t fear him; for I have delivered him, with all his people and his land, into your hand. You shall do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon.” ³So the LORD our God also delivered into our hand Og, the king of Bashan, and all his people. We struck him until no one was left to him remaining. ⁴We took all his cities at that time. There was not a city which we didn’t take from them: sixty cities, all the region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan. ⁵All these were cities fortified with high walls, gates, and bars, in addition to a great many villages without walls. ⁶We utterly destroyed them, as we did to Sihon king of Heshbon, utterly destroying every inhabited city, with the women and the little ones. ⁷But all the livestock, and the plunder of the cities, we took for plunder for ourselves. ⁸We took the land at that time out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, from the valley of the Arnon to Mount Hermon. ⁹(The Sidonians call Hermon Sirion, and the Amorites call it Senir.) ¹⁰We took all the cities of the plain, and all Gilead, and all Bashan, to Salecah and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan. ¹¹(For only Og king of Bashan remained of the remnant of the Rephaim. Behold, his bedstead was a bedstead of iron. Isn’t it in Rabbah of the children of Ammon? Nine cubits ^v was its length, and four cubits its width, after the cubit of a man.) ¹²This land we took in possession at that time: from Aroer, which is by the valley of the Arnon, and half the hill country of Gilead with its cities, I gave to the Reubenites and to the Gadites; ¹³and the rest of Gilead, and all Bashan, the

kingdom of Og, I gave to the half-tribe of Manasseh—all the region of Argob, even all Bashan. (The same is called the land of Rephaim. ¹⁴Jair the son of Manasseh took all the region of Argob, to the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites, and called them, even Bashan, after his own name, Havvoth Jair, to this day.) ¹⁵I gave Gilead to Machir. ¹⁶To the Reubenites and to the Gadites I gave from Gilead even to the valley of the Arnon, the middle of the valley, and its border, even to the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon; ¹⁷the Arabah also, and the Jordan and its border, from Chinnereth even to the sea of the Arabah, the Salt Sea, under the slopes of Pisgah eastward. ¹⁸I commanded you at that time, saying, “The LORD your God has given you this land to possess it. All of you men of valor shall pass over armed before your brothers, the children of Israel. ¹⁹But your wives, and your little ones, and your livestock, (I know that you have much livestock), shall live in your cities which I have given you, ²⁰until the LORD gives rest to your brothers, as to you, and they also possess the land which the LORD your God gives them beyond the Jordan. Then you shall each return to his own possession, which I have given you.” ²¹I commanded Joshua at that time, saying, “Your eyes have seen all that the LORD your God has done to these two kings. So shall the LORD do to all the kingdoms where you go over. ²²You shall not fear them; for the LORD your God himself fights for you.” ²³I begged GOD at that time, saying, ²⁴“Lord ^{vi} GOD, you have begun to show your servant your greatness, and your strong hand. For what god is there in heaven or in earth that can do works like yours, and mighty acts like yours? ²⁵Please let me go over and see the good land that is beyond the Jordan, that fine mountain, and Lebanon.” ²⁶But the LORD was angry with me because of you, and didn’t listen to me. The LORD said to me, “That is enough! Speak no more to me of this matter. ²⁷Go up to the top of Pisgah, and lift up your eyes westward, and northward, and southward, and eastward, and see with your eyes; for you shall not go over this Jordan. ²⁸But commission Joshua, and encourage him, and strengthen him; for he shall go over before this people, and he shall cause them to inherit the land which you shall see.” ²⁹So we stayed in the valley near Beth Peor.

4Now, Israel, listen to the statutes and to the ordinances which I teach you, to do them, that you may live and go in and possess the land which the LORD, the God of your fathers, gives you. ²You shall not add to the word which I command you, neither shall you take away from it, that you may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you. ³Your eyes have seen what the LORD did because of Baal Peor; for the LORD your God has destroyed all the men who followed Baal Peor from among you. ⁴But you who were faithful to the LORD

^vA cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{vi}The word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

your God are all alive today. ⁵Behold, I have taught you statutes and ordinances, even as the LORD my God commanded me, that you should do so in the middle of the land where you go in to possess it. ⁶Keep therefore and do them; for this is your wisdom and your understanding in the sight of the peoples who shall hear all these statutes and say, "Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people." ⁷For what great nation is there that has a god so near to them as the LORD our God is whenever we call on him? ⁸What great nation is there that has statutes and ordinances so righteous as all this law which I set before you today? ⁹Only be careful, and keep your soul diligently, lest you forget the things which your eyes saw, and lest they depart from your heart all the days of your life; but make them known to your children and your children's children— ¹⁰the day that you stood before the LORD your God in Horeb, when the LORD said to me, "Assemble the people to me, and I will make them hear my words, that they may learn to fear me all the days that they live on the earth, and that they may teach their children." ¹¹You came near and stood under the mountain. The mountain burned with fire to the heart of the sky, with darkness, cloud, and thick darkness. ¹²The LORD spoke to you out of the middle of the fire: you heard the voice of words, but you saw no form; you only heard a voice. ¹³He declared to you his covenant, which he commanded you to perform, even the ten commandments. He wrote them on two stone tablets. ¹⁴The LORD commanded me at that time to teach you statutes and ordinances, that you might do them in the land where you go over to possess it. ¹⁵Be very careful, for you saw no kind of form on the day that the LORD spoke to you in Horeb out of the middle of the fire, ¹⁶lest you corrupt yourselves, and make yourself a carved image in the form of any figure, the likeness of male or female, ¹⁷the likeness of any animal that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged bird that flies in the sky, ¹⁸the likeness of anything that creeps on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the water under the earth; ¹⁹and lest you lift up your eyes to the sky, and when you see the sun and the moon and the stars, even all the army of the sky, you are drawn away and worship them, and serve them, which the LORD your God has allotted to all the peoples under the whole sky. ²⁰But the LORD has taken you, and brought you out of the iron furnace, out of Egypt, to be to him a people of inheritance, as it is today. ²¹Furthermore the LORD was angry with me for your sakes, and swore that I should not go over the Jordan, and that I should not go in to that good land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance; ²²but I must die in this land. I must not go over the Jordan, but you shall go over and possess that good land. ²³Be careful, lest you forget the covenant of the LORD your God, which he made with you, and make yourselves a carved image in the form of anything which the LORD your God has for-

bidden you. ²⁴For the LORD your God is a devouring fire, a jealous God. ²⁵When you father children and children's children, and you have been long in the land, and then corrupt yourselves, and make a carved image in the form of anything, and do that which is evil in the LORD your God's sight to provoke him to anger, ²⁶I call heaven and earth to witness against you today, that you will soon utterly perish from off the land which you go over the Jordan to possess it. You will not prolong your days on it, but will utterly be destroyed. ²⁷The LORD will scatter you among the peoples, and you will be left few in number among the nations where the LORD will lead you away. ²⁸There you will serve gods, the work of men's hands, wood and stone, which neither see, nor hear, nor eat, nor smell. ²⁹But from there you shall seek the LORD your God, and you will find him when you search after him with all your heart and with all your soul. ³⁰When you are in oppression, and all these things have come on you, in the latter days you shall return to the LORD your God and listen to his voice. ³¹For the LORD your God is a merciful God. He will not fail you nor destroy you, nor forget the covenant of your fathers which he swore to them. ³²For ask now of the days that are past, which were before you, since the day that God created man on the earth, and from the one end of the sky to the other, whether there has been anything as great as this thing is, or has been heard like it? ³³Did a people ever hear the voice of God speaking out of the middle of the fire, as you have heard, and live? ³⁴Or has God tried to go and take a nation for himself from among another nation, by trials, by signs, by wonders, by war, by a mighty hand, by an outstretched arm, and by great terrors, according to all that the LORD your God did for you in Egypt before your eyes? ³⁵It was shown to you so that you might know that the LORD is God. There is no one else besides him. ³⁶Out of heaven he made you to hear his voice, that he might instruct you. On earth he made you to see his great fire; and you heard his words out of the middle of the fire. ³⁷Because he loved your fathers, therefore he chose their offspring after them, and brought you out with his presence, with his great power, out of Egypt; ³⁸to drive out nations from before you greater and mightier than you, to bring you in, to give you their land for an inheritance, as it is today. ³⁹Know therefore today, and take it to heart, that the LORD himself is God in heaven above and on the earth beneath. There is no one else. ⁴⁰You shall keep his statutes and his commandments which I command you today, that it may go well with you and with your children after you, and that you may prolong your days in the land which the LORD your God gives you for all time. ⁴¹Then Moses set apart three cities beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise, ⁴²that the man slayer might flee there, who kills his neighbor unintentionally and didn't hate him in time past, and that fleeing to one of these cities he might live: ⁴³Bezer in the

wilderness, in the plain country, for the Reubenites; and Ramoth in Gilead for the Gadites; and Golan in Bashan for the Manassites. ⁴⁴This is the law which Moses set before the children of Israel. ⁴⁵These are the testimonies, and the statutes, and the ordinances which Moses spoke to the children of Israel when they came out of Egypt, ⁴⁶beyond the Jordan, in the valley opposite Beth Peor, in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon, whom Moses and the children of Israel struck when they came out of Egypt. ⁴⁷They took possession of his land and the land of Og king of Bashan, the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise; ⁴⁸from Aroer, which is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, even to Mount Zion (also called Hermon), ⁴⁹and all the Arabah beyond the Jordan eastward, even to the sea of the Arabah, under the slopes of Pisgah.

⁵Moses called to all Israel, and said to them, “Hear, Israel, the statutes and the ordinances which I speak in your ears today, that you may learn them, and observe to do them.” ²The LORD our God made a covenant with us in Horeb. ³The LORD didn’t make this covenant with our fathers, but with us, even us, who are all of us here alive today. ⁴The LORD spoke with you face to face on the mountain out of the middle of the fire, ⁵(I stood between the LORD and you at that time, to show you the LORD’s word; for you were afraid because of the fire, and didn’t go up onto the mountain) saying, ⁶“I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ⁷“You shall have no other gods before me. ⁸“You shall not make a carved image for yourself—any likeness of what is in heaven above, or what is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth. ⁹You shall not bow yourself down to them, nor serve them, for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children and on the third and on the fourth generation of those who hate me ¹⁰and showing loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments. ¹¹“You shall not misuse the name of the LORD your God; ^{vii} for the LORD will not hold him guiltless who misuses his name. ¹²“Observe the Sabbath day, to keep it holy, as the LORD your God commanded you. ¹³You shall labor six days, and do all your work; ¹⁴but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God, in which you shall not do any work— neither you, nor your son, nor your daughter, nor your male servant, nor your female servant, nor your ox, nor your donkey, nor any of your livestock, nor your stranger who is within your gates; that your male servant and your female servant may rest as well as you. ¹⁵You shall remember that you were a servant in the land of Egypt, and the LORD your God brought you out of there by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm. Therefore the LORD your God commanded you to keep

^{vii}or, You shall not take the name of Yahweh your God in vain;

the Sabbath day. ¹⁶“Honor your father and your mother, as the LORD your God commanded you, that your days may be long and that it may go well with you in the land which the LORD your God gives you. ¹⁷“You shall not murder. ¹⁸“You shall not commit adultery. ¹⁹“You shall not steal. ²⁰“You shall not give false testimony against your neighbor. ²¹“You shall not covet your neighbor’s wife. Neither shall you desire your neighbor’s house, his field, or his male servant, or his female servant, his ox, or his donkey, or anything that is your neighbor’s.” ²²The LORD spoke these words to all your assembly on the mountain out of the middle of the fire, of the cloud, and of the thick darkness, with a great voice. He added no more. He wrote them on two stone tablets, and gave them to me. ²³When you heard the voice out of the middle of the darkness, while the mountain was burning with fire, you came near to me, even all the heads of your tribes, and your elders; ²⁴and you said, “Behold, the LORD our God has shown us his glory and his greatness, and we have heard his voice out of the middle of the fire. We have seen today that God does speak with man, and he lives. ²⁵Now therefore, why should we die? For this great fire will consume us. If we hear the LORD our God’s voice any more, then we shall die. ²⁶For who is there of all flesh who has heard the voice of the living God speaking out of the middle of the fire, as we have, and lived? ²⁷Go near, and hear all that the LORD our God shall say, and tell us all that the LORD our God tells you; and we will hear it, and do it.” ²⁸The LORD heard the voice of your words when you spoke to me; and the LORD said to me, “I have heard the voice of the words of this people which they have spoken to you. They have well said all that they have spoken. ²⁹Oh that there were such a heart in them that they would fear me and keep all my commandments always, that it might be well with them and with their children forever! ³⁰“Go tell them, ‘Return to your tents.’ ³¹But as for you, stand here by me, and I will tell you all the commandments, and the statutes, and the ordinances, which you shall teach them, that they may do them in the land which I give them to possess.” ³²You shall observe to do therefore as the LORD your God has commanded you. You shall not turn away to the right hand or to the left. ³³You shall walk in all the way which the LORD your God has commanded you, that you may live and that it may be well with you, and that you may prolong your days in the land which you shall possess.

⁶Now these are the commandments, the statutes, and the ordinances, which the LORD your God commanded to teach you, that you might do them in the land that you go over to possess; ²that you might fear the LORD your God, to keep all his statutes and his commandments, which I command you—you, your son, and your son’s son, all the days of your life; and that your days may be prolonged.

³Hear therefore, Israel, and observe to do it, that it may be well with you, and that you may increase mightily, as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has promised to you, in a land flowing with milk and honey. ⁴Hear, Israel: the LORD is our God. The LORD is one. ⁵You shall love the LORD your God with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your might. ⁶These words, which I command you today, shall be on your heart; ⁷and you shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise up. ⁸You shall bind them for a sign on your hand, and they shall be for frontlets between your eyes. ⁹You shall write them on the door posts of your house and on your gates. ¹⁰It shall be, when the LORD your God brings you into the land which he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give you, great and goodly cities which you didn't build, ¹¹and houses full of all good things which you didn't fill, and cisterns dug out which you didn't dig, vineyards and olive trees which you didn't plant, and you shall eat and be full; ¹²then beware lest you forget the LORD, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ¹³You shall fear the LORD your God; and you shall serve him, and shall swear by his name. ¹⁴You shall not go after other gods, of the gods of the peoples who are around you, ¹⁵for the LORD your God among you is a jealous God, lest the anger of the LORD your God be kindled against you, and he destroy you from off the face of the earth. ¹⁶You shall not tempt the LORD your God, as you tempted him in Massah. ¹⁷You shall diligently keep the commandments of the LORD your God, and his testimonies, and his statutes, which he has commanded you. ¹⁸You shall do that which is right and good in the LORD's sight, that it may be well with you and that you may go in and possess the good land which the LORD swore to your fathers, ¹⁹to thrust out all your enemies from before you, as the LORD has spoken. ²⁰When your son asks you in time to come, saying, "What do the testimonies, the statutes, and the ordinances, which the LORD our God has commanded you mean?" ²¹then you shall tell your son, "We were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt. The LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand; ²²and the LORD showed great and awesome signs and wonders on Egypt, on Pharaoh, and on all his house, before our eyes; ²³and he brought us out from there, that he might bring us in, to give us the land which he swore to our fathers. ²⁴The LORD commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear the LORD our God, for our good always, that he might preserve us alive, as we are today. ²⁵It shall be righteousness to us, if we observe to do all these commandments before the LORD our God, as he has commanded us."

⁷When the LORD your God brings you into the land where you go to possess it, and casts out many nations

before you—the Hittite, the Girgashite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite—seven nations greater and mightier than you; ²and when the LORD your God delivers them up before you, and you strike them, then you shall utterly destroy them. You shall make no covenant with them, nor show mercy to them. ³You shall not make marriages with them. You shall not give your daughter to his son, nor shall you take his daughter for your son. ⁴For that would turn away your sons from following me, that they may serve other gods. So the LORD's anger would be kindled against you, and he would destroy you quickly. ⁵But you shall deal with them like this: you shall break down their altars, dash their pillars in pieces, cut down their Asherah poles, and burn their engraved images with fire. ⁶For you are a holy people to the LORD your God. The LORD your God has chosen you to be a people for his own possession, above all peoples who are on the face of the earth. ⁷The LORD didn't set his love on you nor choose you, because you were more in number than any people; for you were the fewest of all peoples; ⁸but because the LORD loves you, and because he desires to keep the oath which he swore to your fathers, the LORD has brought you out with a mighty hand and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt. ⁹Know therefore that the LORD your God himself is God, the faithful God, who keeps covenant and loving kindness to a thousand generations with those who love him and keep his commandments, ¹⁰and repays those who hate him to their face, to destroy them. He will not be slack to him who hates him. He will repay him to his face. ¹¹You shall therefore keep the commandments, the statutes, and the ordinances which I command you today, to do them. ¹²It shall happen, because you listen to these ordinances and keep and do them, that the LORD your God will keep with you the covenant and the loving kindness which he swore to your fathers. ¹³He will love you, bless you, and multiply you. He will also bless the fruit of your body and the fruit of your ground, your grain and your new wine and your oil, the increase of your livestock and the young of your flock, in the land which he swore to your fathers to give you. ¹⁴You will be blessed above all peoples. There won't be male or female barren among you, or among your livestock. ¹⁵The LORD will take away from you all sickness; and he will put none of the evil diseases of Egypt, which you know, on you, but will lay them on all those who hate you. ¹⁶You shall consume all the peoples whom the LORD your God shall deliver to you. Your eye shall not pity them. You shall not serve their gods; for that would be a snare to you. ¹⁷If you shall say in your heart, "These nations are more than I; how can I dispossess them?" ¹⁸you shall not be afraid of them. You shall remember well what the LORD your God did to Pharaoh and to all Egypt: ¹⁹the great trials which your eyes saw, the signs, the wonders, the mighty hand, and the

outstretched arm, by which the LORD your God brought you out. So shall the LORD your God do to all the peoples of whom you are afraid. ²⁰Moreover the LORD your God will send the hornet among them, until those who are left, and hide themselves, perish from before you. ²¹You shall not be scared of them; for the LORD your God is among you, a great and awesome God. ²²The LORD your God will cast out those nations before you little by little. You may not consume them at once, lest the animals of the field increase on you. ²³But the LORD your God will deliver them up before you, and will confuse them with a great confusion, until they are destroyed. ²⁴He will deliver their kings into your hand, and you shall make their name perish from under the sky. No one will be able to stand before you until you have destroyed them. ²⁵You shall burn the engraved images of their gods with fire. You shall not covet the silver or the gold that is on them, nor take it for yourself, lest you be snared in it; for it is an abomination to the LORD your God. ²⁶You shall not bring an abomination into your house and become a devoted thing like it. You shall utterly detest it. You shall utterly abhor it; for it is a devoted thing.

⁸You shall observe to do all the commandments which I command you today, that you may live, and multiply, and go in and possess the land which the LORD swore to your fathers. ²You shall remember all the way which the LORD your God has led you these forty years in the wilderness, that he might humble you, to test you, to know what was in your heart, whether you would keep his commandments or not. ³He humbled you, allowed you to be hungry, and fed you with manna, which you didn't know, neither did your fathers know, that he might teach you that man does not live by bread only, but man lives by every word that proceeds out of the LORD's mouth. ⁴Your clothing didn't grow old on you, neither did your foot swell, these forty years. ⁵You shall consider in your heart that as a man disciplines his son, so the LORD your God disciplines you. ⁶You shall keep the commandments of the LORD your God, to walk in his ways, and to fear him. ⁷For the LORD your God brings you into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of springs, and underground water flowing into valleys and hills; ⁸a land of wheat, barley, vines, fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of olive trees and honey; ⁹a land in which you shall eat bread without scarcity, you shall not lack anything in it; a land whose stones are iron, and out of whose hills you may dig copper. ¹⁰You shall eat and be full, and you shall bless the LORD your God for the good land which he has given you. ¹¹Beware lest you forget the LORD your God, in not keeping his commandments, his ordinances, and his statutes, which I command you today; ¹²lest, when you have eaten and are full, and have built fine houses and lived in them; ¹³and when your herds and your flocks multiply, and your silver and your gold is

multiplied, and all that you have is multiplied; ¹⁴then your heart might be lifted up, and you forget the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage; ¹⁵who led you through the great and terrible wilderness, with venomous snakes and scorpions, and thirsty ground where there was no water; who poured water for you out of the rock of flint; ¹⁶who fed you in the wilderness with manna, which your fathers didn't know, that he might humble you, and that he might prove you, to do you good at your latter end; ¹⁷and lest you say in your heart, "My power and the might of my hand has gotten me this wealth." ¹⁸But you shall remember the LORD your God, for it is he who gives you power to get wealth, that he may establish his covenant which he swore to your fathers, as it is today. ¹⁹It shall be, if you shall forget the LORD your God, and walk after other gods, and serve them and worship them, I testify against you today that you shall surely perish. ²⁰As the nations that the LORD makes to perish before you, so you shall perish, because you wouldn't listen to the LORD your God's voice.

⁹Hear, Israel! You are to pass over the Jordan today, to go in to dispossess nations greater and mightier than yourself, cities great and fortified up to the sky, ²a people great and tall, the sons of the Anakim, whom you know, and of whom you have heard say, "Who can stand before the sons of Anak?" ³Know therefore today that the LORD your God is he who goes over before you as a devouring fire. He will destroy them and he will bring them down before you. So you shall drive them out and make them perish quickly, as the LORD has spoken to you. ⁴Don't say in your heart, after the LORD your God has thrust them out from before you, "For my righteousness the LORD has brought me in to possess this land;" because the LORD drives them out before you because of the wickedness of these nations. ⁵Not for your righteousness or for the uprightness of your heart do you go in to possess their land; but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD your God does drive them out from before you, and that he may establish the word which the LORD swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob. ⁶Know therefore that the LORD your God doesn't give you this good land to possess for your righteousness, for you are a stiff-necked people. ⁷Remember, and don't forget, how you provoked the LORD your God to wrath in the wilderness. From the day that you left the land of Egypt until you came to this place, you have been rebellious against the LORD. ⁸Also in Horeb you provoked the LORD to wrath, and the LORD was angry with you to destroy you. ⁹When I had gone up onto the mountain to receive the stone tablets, even the tablets of the covenant which the LORD made with you, then I stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water. ¹⁰The LORD delivered to me the two stone tablets written with God's

finger. On them were all the words which the LORD spoke with you on the mountain out of the middle of the fire in the day of the assembly. ¹¹It came to pass at the end of forty days and forty nights that the LORD gave me the two stone tablets, even the tablets of the covenant. ¹²The LORD said to me, "Arise, get down quickly from here; for your people whom you have brought out of Egypt have corrupted themselves. They have quickly turned away from the way which I commanded them. They have made a molten image for themselves!" ¹³Furthermore the LORD spoke to me, saying, "I have seen these people, and behold, they are a stiff-necked people. ¹⁴Leave me alone, that I may destroy them, and blot out their name from under the sky; and I will make of you a nation mightier and greater than they." ¹⁵So I turned and came down from the mountain, and the mountain was burning with fire. The two tablets of the covenant were in my two hands. ¹⁶I looked, and behold, you had sinned against the LORD your God. You had made yourselves a molded calf. You had quickly turned away from the way which the LORD had commanded you. ¹⁷I took hold of the two tablets, and threw them out of my two hands, and broke them before your eyes. ¹⁸I fell down before the LORD, as at the first, forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water, because of all your sin which you sinned, in doing that which was evil in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger. ¹⁹For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure with which the LORD was angry against you to destroy you. But the LORD listened to me that time also. ²⁰The LORD was angry enough with Aaron to destroy him. I prayed for Aaron also at the same time. ²¹I took your sin, the calf which you had made, and burned it with fire, and crushed it, grinding it very small, until it was as fine as dust. I threw its dust into the brook that descended out of the mountain. ²²At Taberah, at Massah, and at Kibroth Hattaavah you provoked the LORD to wrath. ²³When the LORD sent you from Kadesh Barnea, saying, "Go up and possess the land which I have given you," you rebelled against the commandment of the LORD your God, and you didn't believe him or listen to his voice. ²⁴You have been rebellious against the LORD from the day that I knew you. ²⁵So I fell down before the LORD the forty days and forty nights that I fell down, because the LORD had said he would destroy you. ²⁶I prayed to the LORD, and said, "Lord GOD, don't destroy your people and your inheritance that you have redeemed through your greatness, that you have brought out of Egypt with a mighty hand. ²⁷Remember your servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Don't look at the stubbornness of this people, nor at their wickedness, nor at their sin, ²⁸lest the land you brought us out from say, 'Because the LORD was not able to bring them into the land which he promised to them, and because he hated them, he has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness.' ²⁹Yet they are your people

and your inheritance, which you brought out by your great power and by your outstretched arm."

¹⁰At that time the LORD said to me, "Cut two stone tablets like the first, and come up to me onto the mountain, and make an ark of wood. ²I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets which you broke, and you shall put them in the ark." ³So I made an ark of acacia wood, and cut two stone tablets like the first, and went up onto the mountain, having the two tablets in my hand. ⁴He wrote on the tablets, according to the first writing, the ten commandments, which the LORD spoke to you on the mountain out of the middle of the fire in the day of the assembly; and the LORD gave them to me. ⁵I turned and came down from the mountain, and put the tablets in the ark which I had made; and there they are as the LORD commanded me. ⁶(The children of Israel traveled from Beeroth Bene Jaakan to Moserah. There Aaron died, and there he was buried; and Eleazar his son ministered in the priest's office in his place. ⁷From there they traveled to Gudgodah; and from Gudgodah to Jotbathah, a land of brooks of water. ⁸At that time the LORD set apart the tribe of Levi to bear the ark of the LORD's covenant, to stand before the LORD to minister to him, and to bless in his name, to this day. ⁹Therefore Levi has no portion nor inheritance with his brothers; the LORD is his inheritance, according as the LORD your God spoke to him.) ¹⁰I stayed on the mountain, as at the first time, forty days and forty nights; and the LORD listened to me that time also. The LORD would not destroy you. ¹¹The LORD said to me, "Arise, take your journey before the people; and they shall go in and possess the land which I swore to their fathers to give to them." ¹²Now, Israel, what does the LORD your God require of you, but to fear the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, to love him, and to serve the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul, ¹³to keep the LORD's commandments and statutes, which I command you today for your good? ¹⁴Behold, to the LORD your God belongs heaven, the heaven of heavens, and the earth, with all that is therein. ¹⁵Only the LORD had a delight in your fathers to love them, and he chose their offspring after them, even you above all peoples, as it is today. ¹⁶Circumcise therefore the foreskin of your heart, and be no more stiff-necked. ¹⁷For the LORD your God, he is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great God, the mighty, and the awesome, who doesn't respect persons or take bribes. ¹⁸He executes justice for the fatherless and widow and loves the foreigner in giving him food and clothing. ¹⁹Therefore love the foreigner, for you were foreigners in the land of Egypt. ²⁰You shall fear the LORD your God. You shall serve him. You shall cling to him, and you shall swear by his name. ²¹He is your praise, and he is your God, who has done for you these great and awesome things which your eyes have seen. ²²Your fathers

went down into Egypt with seventy persons; and now the LORD your God has made you as the stars of the sky for multitude.

11 Therefore you shall love the LORD your God, and keep his instructions, his statutes, his ordinances, and his commandments, always. ² Know this day—for I don't speak with your children who have not known, and who have not seen the chastisement of the LORD your God, his greatness, his mighty hand, his outstretched arm, ³ his signs, and his works, which he did in the middle of Egypt to Pharaoh the king of Egypt, and to all his land; ⁴ and what he did to the army of Egypt, to their horses, and to their chariots; how he made the water of the Sea of Suf to overflow them as they pursued you, and how the LORD has destroyed them to this day; ⁵ and what he did to you in the wilderness until you came to this place; ⁶ and what he did to Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, the son of Reuben—how the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up, with their households, their tents, and every living thing that followed them, in the middle of all Israel; ⁷ but your eyes have seen all of the LORD's great work which he did. ⁸ Therefore you shall keep the entire commandment which I command you today, that you may be strong, and go in and possess the land that you go over to possess; ⁹ and that you may prolong your days in the land which the LORD swore to your fathers to give to them and to their offspring, a land flowing with milk and honey. ¹⁰ For the land, where you go in to possess isn't like the land of Egypt that you came out of, where you sowed your seed and watered it with your foot, as a garden of herbs; ¹¹ but the land that you go over to possess is a land of hills and valleys which drinks water from the rain of the sky, ¹² a land which the LORD your God cares for. The LORD your God's eyes are always on it, from the beginning of the year even to the end of the year. ¹³ It shall happen, if you shall listen diligently to my commandments which I command you today, to love the LORD your God, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul, ¹⁴ that I will give the rain for your land in its season, the early rain and the latter rain, that you may gather in your grain, your new wine, and your oil. ¹⁵ I will give grass in your fields for your livestock, and you shall eat and be full. ¹⁶ Be careful, lest your heart be deceived, and you turn away to serve other gods and worship them; ¹⁷ and the LORD's anger be kindled against you, and he shut up the sky so that there is no rain, and the land doesn't yield its fruit; and you perish quickly from off the good land which the LORD gives you. ¹⁸ Therefore you shall lay up these words of mine in your heart and in your soul. You shall bind them for a sign on your hand, and they shall be for frontlets between your eyes. ¹⁹ You shall teach them to your children, talking of them when you sit in your house, when you walk by the way, when you lie down, and when you rise up. ²⁰ You

shall write them on the door posts of your house and on your gates; ²¹ that your days and your children's days may be multiplied in the land which the LORD swore to your fathers to give them, as the days of the heavens above the earth. ²² For if you shall diligently keep all these commandments which I command you—to do them, to love the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, and to cling to him—²³ then the LORD will drive out all these nations from before you, and you shall dispossess nations greater and mightier than yourselves. ²⁴ Every place on which the sole of your foot treads shall be yours: from the wilderness and Lebanon, from the river, the river Euphrates, even to the western sea shall be your border. ²⁵ No man will be able to stand before you. The LORD your God will lay the fear of you and the dread of you on all the land that you tread on, as he has spoken to you. ²⁶ Behold, I set before you today a blessing and a curse: ²⁷ the blessing, if you listen to the commandments of the LORD your God, which I command you today; ²⁸ and the curse, if you do not listen to the commandments of the LORD your God, but turn away out of the way which I command you today, to go after other gods which you have not known. ²⁹ It shall happen, when the LORD your God brings you into the land that you go to possess, that you shall set the blessing on Mount Gerizim, and the curse on Mount Ebal. ³⁰ Aren't they beyond the Jordan, behind the way of the going down of the sun, in the land of the Canaanites who dwell in the Arabah near Gilgal, beside the oaks of Moreh? ³¹ For you are to pass over the Jordan to go in to possess the land which the LORD your God gives you, and you shall possess it and dwell in it. ³² You shall observe to do all the statutes and the ordinances which I set before you today.

12 These are the statutes and the ordinances which you shall observe to do in the land which the LORD, the God of your fathers, has given you to possess all the days that you live on the earth. ² You shall surely destroy all the places in which the nations that you shall dispossess served their gods: on the high mountains, and on the hills, and under every green tree. ³ You shall break down their altars, dash their pillars in pieces, and burn their Asherah poles with fire. You shall cut down the engraved images of their gods. You shall destroy their name out of that place. ⁴ You shall not do so to the LORD your God. ⁵ But to the place which the LORD your God shall choose out of all your tribes, to put his name there, you shall seek his habitation, and you shall come there. ⁶ You shall bring your burnt offerings, your sacrifices, your tithes, the wave offering of your hand, your vows, your free will offerings, and the firstborn of your herd and of your flock there. ⁷ There you shall eat before the LORD your God, and you shall rejoice in all that you put your hand to, you and your households, in which the LORD your God has blessed you. ⁸ You shall not do all the things that we do here today, every man

whatever is right in his own eyes; ⁹for you haven't yet come to the rest and to the inheritance which the LORD your God gives you. ¹⁰But when you go over the Jordan and dwell in the land which the LORD your God causes you to inherit, and he gives you rest from all your enemies around you, so that you dwell in safety, ¹¹then it shall happen that to the place which the LORD your God shall choose, to cause his name to dwell there, there you shall bring all that I command you: your burnt offerings, your sacrifices, your tithes, the wave offering of your hand, and all your choice vows which you vow to the LORD. ¹²You shall rejoice before the LORD your God—you, and your sons, your daughters, your male servants, your female servants, and the Levite who is within your gates, because he has no portion nor inheritance with you. ¹³Be careful that you don't offer your burnt offerings in every place that you see; ¹⁴but in the place which the LORD chooses in one of your tribes, there you shall offer your burnt offerings, and there you shall do all that I command you. ¹⁵Yet you may kill and eat meat within all your gates, after all the desire of your soul, according to the LORD your God's blessing which he has given you. The unclean and the clean may eat of it, as of the gazelle and the deer. ¹⁶Only you shall not eat the blood. You shall pour it out on the earth like water. ¹⁷You may not eat within your gates the tithe of your grain, or of your new wine, or of your oil, or the first-born of your herd or of your flock, nor any of your vows which you vow, nor your free will offerings, nor the wave offering of your hand; ¹⁸but you shall eat them before the LORD your God in the place which the LORD your God shall choose: you, your son, your daughter, your male servant, your female servant, and the Levite who is within your gates. You shall rejoice before the LORD your God in all that you put your hand to. ¹⁹Be careful that you don't forsake the Levite as long as you live in your land. ²⁰When the LORD your God enlarges your border, as he has promised you, and you say, "I want to eat meat," because your soul desires to eat meat, you may eat meat, after all the desire of your soul. ²¹If the place which the LORD your God shall choose to put his name is too far from you, then you shall kill of your herd and of your flock, which the LORD has given you, as I have commanded you; and you may eat within your gates, after all the desire of your soul. ²²Even as the gazelle and as the deer is eaten, so you shall eat of it. The unclean and the clean may eat of it alike. ²³Only be sure that you don't eat the blood; for the blood is the life. You shall not eat the life with the meat. ²⁴You shall not eat it. You shall pour it out on the earth like water. ²⁵You shall not eat it, that it may go well with you and with your children after you, when you do that which is right in the LORD's eyes. ²⁶Only your holy things which you have, and your vows, you shall take and go to the place which the LORD shall choose. ²⁷You shall offer your burnt offerings, the meat and the blood,

on the LORD your God's altar. The blood of your sacrifices shall be poured out on the LORD your God's altar, and you shall eat the meat. ²⁸Observe and hear all these words which I command you, that it may go well with you and with your children after you forever, when you do that which is good and right in the LORD your God's eyes. ²⁹When the LORD your God cuts off the nations from before you where you go in to dispossess them, and you dispossess them and dwell in their land, ³⁰be careful that you are not ensnared to follow them after they are destroyed from before you, and that you not inquire after their gods, saying, "How do these nations serve their gods? I will do likewise." ³¹You shall not do so to the LORD your God; for every abomination to the LORD, which he hates, they have done to their gods; for they even burn their sons and their daughters in the fire to their gods. ³²Whatever thing I command you, that you shall observe to do. You shall not add to it, nor take away from it.

13If a prophet or a dreamer of dreams arises among you, and he gives you a sign or a wonder, ²and the sign or the wonder comes to pass, of which he spoke to you, saying, "Let's go after other gods" (which you have not known) "and let's serve them," ³you shall not listen to the words of that prophet, or to that dreamer of dreams; for the LORD your God is testing you, to know whether you love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul. ⁴You shall walk after the LORD your God, fear him, keep his commandments, and obey his voice. You shall serve him, and cling to him. ⁵That prophet, or that dreamer of dreams, shall be put to death, because he has spoken rebellion against the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, to draw you aside out of the way which the LORD your God commanded you to walk in. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ⁶If your brother, the son of your mother, or your son, or your daughter, or the wife of your bosom, or your friend who is as your own soul, entices you secretly, saying, "Let's go and serve other gods"—which you have not known, you, nor your fathers; ⁷of the gods of the peoples who are around you, near to you, or far off from you, from the one end of the earth even to the other end of the earth—⁸you shall not consent to him nor listen to him; neither shall your eye pity him, neither shall you spare, neither shall you conceal him; ⁹but you shall surely kill him. Your hand shall be first on him to put him to death, and afterwards the hands of all the people. ¹⁰You shall stone him to death with stones, because he has sought to draw you away from the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ¹¹All Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall not do any more wickedness like this among you. ¹²If you hear about one of your cities, which the LORD your God gives you to dwell there, that ¹³certain wicked fellows

have gone out from among you and have drawn away the inhabitants of their city, saying, "Let's go and serve other gods," which you have not known, ¹⁴then you shall inquire, investigate, and ask diligently. Behold, if it is true, and the thing certain, that such abomination was done among you, ¹⁵you shall surely strike the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying it utterly, with all that is therein and its livestock, with the edge of the sword. ¹⁶You shall gather all its plunder into the middle of its street, and shall burn with fire the city, with all of its plunder, to the LORD your God. It shall be a heap forever. It shall not be built again. ¹⁷Nothing of the devoted thing shall cling to your hand, that the LORD may turn from the fierceness of his anger and show you mercy, and have compassion on you and multiply you, as he has sworn to your fathers, ¹⁸when you listen to the LORD your God's voice, to keep all his commandments which I command you today, to do that which is right in the LORD your God's eyes.

¹⁴You are the children of the LORD your God. You shall not cut yourselves, nor make any baldness between your eyes for the dead. ²For you are a holy people to the LORD your God, and the LORD has chosen you to be a people for his own possession, above all peoples who are on the face of the earth. ³You shall not eat any abominable thing. ⁴These are the animals which you may eat: the ox, the sheep, the goat, ⁵the deer, the gazelle, the roebuck, the wild goat, the ibex, the antelope, and the chamois. ⁶Every animal that parts the hoof, and has the hoof split in two and chews the cud, among the animals, you may eat. ⁷Nevertheless these you shall not eat of them that chew the cud, or of those who have the hoof split: the camel, the hare, and the rabbit. Because they chew the cud but don't part the hoof, they are unclean to you. ⁸The pig, because it has a split hoof but doesn't chew the cud, is unclean to you. You shall not eat their meat. You shall not touch their carcasses. ⁹These you may eat of all that are in the waters: you may eat whatever has fins and scales. ¹⁰You shall not eat whatever doesn't have fins and scales. It is unclean to you. ¹¹Of all clean birds you may eat. ¹²But these are they of which you shall not eat: the eagle, the vulture, the osprey, ¹³the red kite, the falcon, the kite of any kind, ¹⁴every raven of any kind, ¹⁵the ostrich, the owl, the seagull, the hawk of any kind, ¹⁶the little owl, the great owl, the horned owl, ¹⁷the pelican, the vulture, the cormorant, ¹⁸the stork, the heron after its kind, the hoopoe, and the bat. ¹⁹All winged creeping things are unclean to you. They shall not be eaten. ²⁰Of all clean birds you may eat. ²¹You shall not eat of anything that dies of itself. You may give it to the foreigner living among you who is within your gates, that he may eat it; or you may sell it to a foreigner; for you are a holy people to the LORD your God. You shall not boil a young goat in its mother's milk. ²²You shall surely tithe all the increase

of your seed, that which comes out of the field year by year. ²³You shall eat before the LORD your God, in the place which he chooses to cause his name to dwell, the tithe of your grain, of your new wine, and of your oil, and the firstborn of your herd and of your flock; that you may learn to fear the LORD your God always. ²⁴If the way is too long for you, so that you are not able to carry it because the place which the LORD your God shall choose to set his name there is too far from you, when the LORD your God blesses you, ²⁵then you shall turn it into money, bind up the money in your hand, and shall go to the place which the LORD your God shall choose. ²⁶You shall trade the money for whatever your soul desires: for cattle, or for sheep, or for wine, or for strong drink, or for whatever your soul asks of you. You shall eat there before the LORD your God, and you shall rejoice, you and your household. ²⁷You shall not forsake the Levite who is within your gates, for he has no portion nor inheritance with you. ²⁸At the end of every three years you shall bring all the tithe of your increase in the same year, and shall store it within your gates. ²⁹The Levite, because he has no portion nor inheritance with you, as well as the foreigner living among you, the fatherless, and the widow who are within your gates shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD your God may bless you in all the work of your hand which you do.

¹⁵At the end of every seven years, you shall cancel debts. ²This is the way it shall be done: every creditor shall release that which he has lent to his neighbor. He shall not require payment from his neighbor and his brother, because the LORD's release has been proclaimed. ³Of a foreigner you may require it; but whatever of yours is with your brother, your hand shall release. ⁴However there will be no poor with you (for the LORD will surely bless you in the land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance to possess) ⁵if only you diligently listen to the LORD your God's voice, to observe to do all this commandment which I command you today. ⁶For the LORD your God will bless you, as he promised you. You will lend to many nations, but you will not borrow. You will rule over many nations, but they will not rule over you. ⁷If a poor man, one of your brothers, is with you within any of your gates in your land which the LORD your God gives you, you shall not harden your heart, nor shut your hand from your poor brother; ⁸but you shall surely open your hand to him, and shall surely lend him sufficient for his need, which he lacks. ⁹Beware that there not be a wicked thought in your heart, saying, "The seventh year, the year of release, is at hand," and your eye be evil against your poor brother and you give him nothing; and he cry to the LORD against you, and it be sin to you. ¹⁰You shall surely give, and your heart shall not be grieved when you give to him, because it is for this thing the LORD your God will

bless you in all your work and in all that you put your hand to. ¹¹For the poor will never cease out of the land. Therefore I command you to surely open your hand to your brother, to your needy, and to your poor, in your land. ¹²If your brother, a Hebrew man, or a Hebrew woman, is sold to you and serves you six years, then in the seventh year you shall let him go free from you. ¹³When you let him go free from you, you shall not let him go empty. ¹⁴You shall furnish him liberally out of your flock, out of your threshing floor, and out of your wine press. As the LORD your God has blessed you, you shall give to him. ¹⁵You shall remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt, and the LORD your God redeemed you. Therefore I command you this thing today. ¹⁶It shall be, if he tells you, "I will not go out from you," because he loves you and your house, because he is well with you, ¹⁷then you shall take an awl, and thrust it through his ear to the door, and he shall be your servant forever. Also to your female servant you shall do likewise. ¹⁸It shall not seem hard to you when you let him go free from you, for he has been double the value of a hired hand as he served you six years. The LORD your God will bless you in all that you do. ¹⁹You shall dedicate all the firstborn males that are born of your herd and of your flock to the LORD your God. You shall do no work with the firstborn of your herd, nor shear the firstborn of your flock. ²⁰You shall eat it before the LORD your God year by year in the place which the LORD shall choose, you and your household. ²¹If it has any defect—is lame or blind, or has any defect whatever, you shall not sacrifice it to the LORD your God. ²²You shall eat it within your gates. The unclean and the clean shall eat it alike, as the gazelle and as the deer. ²³Only you shall not eat its blood. You shall pour it out on the ground like water.

16Observe the month of Abib, and keep the Passover to the LORD your God; for in the month of Abib the LORD your God brought you out of Egypt by night. ²You shall sacrifice the Passover to the LORD your God, of the flock and the herd, in the place which the LORD shall choose to cause his name to dwell there. ³You shall eat no leavened bread with it. You shall eat unleavened bread with it seven days, even the bread of affliction (for you came out of the land of Egypt in haste) that you may remember the day when you came out of the land of Egypt all the days of your life. ⁴No yeast shall be seen with you in all your borders seven days; neither shall any of the meat, which you sacrifice the first day at evening, remain all night until the morning. ⁵You may not sacrifice the Passover within any of your gates which the LORD your God gives you; ⁶but at the place which the LORD your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell in, there you shall sacrifice the Passover at evening, at the going down of the sun, at the season that you came out of Egypt. ⁷You shall roast and eat it in the place which the LORD your God

chooses. In the morning you shall return to your tents. ⁸Six days you shall eat unleavened bread. On the seventh day shall be a solemn assembly to the LORD your God. You shall do no work. ⁹You shall count for yourselves seven weeks. From the time you begin to put the sickle to the standing grain you shall begin to count seven weeks. ¹⁰You shall keep the feast of weeks to the LORD your God with a tribute of a free will offering of your hand, which you shall give according to how the LORD your God blesses you. ¹¹You shall rejoice before the LORD your God: you, your son, your daughter, your male servant, your female servant, the Levite who is within your gates, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow who are among you, in the place which the LORD your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell there. ¹²You shall remember that you were a slave in Egypt. You shall observe and do these statutes. ¹³You shall keep the feast of booths seven days, after you have gathered in from your threshing floor and from your wine press. ¹⁴You shall rejoice in your feast, you, your son, your daughter, your male servant, your female servant, the Levite, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow who are within your gates. ¹⁵You shall keep a feast to the LORD your God seven days in the place which the LORD chooses, because the LORD your God will bless you in all your increase and in all the work of your hands, and you shall be altogether joyful. ¹⁶Three times in a year all of your males shall appear before the LORD your God in the place which he chooses: in the feast of unleavened bread, in the feast of weeks, and in the feast of booths. They shall not appear before the LORD empty. ¹⁷Every man shall give as he is able, according to the LORD your God's blessing which he has given you. ¹⁸You shall make judges and officers in all your gates, which the LORD your God gives you, according to your tribes; and they shall judge the people with righteous judgment. ¹⁹You shall not pervert justice. You shall not show partiality. You shall not take a bribe, for a bribe blinds the eyes of the wise and perverts the words of the righteous. ²⁰You shall follow that which is altogether just, that you may live and inherit the land which the LORD your God gives you. ²¹You shall not plant for yourselves an Asherah of any kind of tree beside the LORD your God's altar, which you shall make for yourselves. ²²Neither shall you set yourself up a sacred stone which the LORD your God hates.

17You shall not sacrifice to the LORD your God an ox or a sheep in which is a defect or anything evil; for that is an abomination to the LORD your God. ²If there is found among you, within any of your gates which the LORD your God gives you, a man or woman who does that which is evil in the LORD your God's sight in transgressing his covenant, ³and has gone and served other gods and worshiped them, or the sun, or the moon, or any of the stars of the sky, which I have not commanded, ⁴and

you are told, and you have heard of it, then you shall inquire diligently. Behold, if it is true, and the thing certain, that such abomination is done in Israel, ⁵then you shall bring out that man or that woman who has done this evil thing to your gates, even that same man or woman; and you shall stone them to death with stones. ⁶At the mouth of two witnesses, or three witnesses, he who is to die shall be put to death. At the mouth of one witness he shall not be put to death. ⁷The hands of the witnesses shall be first on him to put him to death, and afterward the hands of all the people. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ⁸If there arises a matter too hard for you in judgment, between blood and blood, between plea and plea, and between stroke and stroke, being matters of controversy within your gates, then you shall arise, and go up to the place which the LORD your God chooses. ⁹You shall come to the priests who are Levites and to the judge who shall be in those days. You shall inquire, and they shall give you the verdict. ¹⁰You shall do according to the decisions of the verdict which they shall give you from that place which the LORD chooses. You shall observe to do according to all that they shall teach you. ¹¹According to the decisions of the law which they shall teach you, and according to the judgment which they shall tell you, you shall do. You shall not turn away from the sentence which they announce to you, to the right hand, nor to the left. ¹²The man who does presumptuously in not listening to the priest who stands to minister there before the LORD your God, or to the judge, even that man shall die. You shall put away the evil from Israel. ¹³All the people shall hear and fear, and do no more presumptuously. ¹⁴When you have come to the land which the LORD your God gives you, and possess it and dwell in it, and say, "I will set a king over me, like all the nations that are around me," ¹⁵you shall surely set him whom the LORD your God chooses as king over yourselves. You shall set as king over you one from among your brothers. You may not put a foreigner over you, who is not your brother. ¹⁶Only he shall not multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt, to the end that he may multiply horses; because the LORD has said to you, "You shall not go back that way again." ¹⁷He shall not multiply wives to himself, that his heart not turn away. He shall not greatly multiply to himself silver and gold. ¹⁸It shall be, when he sits on the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write himself a copy of this law in a book, out of that which is before the Levitical priests. ¹⁹It shall be with him, and he shall read from it all the days of his life, that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them; ²⁰that his heart not be lifted up above his brothers, and that he not turn away from the commandment to the right hand, or to the left, to the end that he may prolong his days in his kingdom, he and his children, in the middle of Israel.

¹⁸The priests and the Levites—all the tribe of Levi—shall have no portion nor inheritance with Israel. They shall eat the offerings of the LORD made by fire and his portion. ²They shall have no inheritance among their brothers. The LORD is their inheritance, as he has spoken to them. ³This shall be the priests' due from the people, from those who offer a sacrifice, whether it be ox or sheep, that they shall give to the priest: the shoulder, the two cheeks, and the inner parts. ⁴You shall give him the first fruits of your grain, of your new wine, and of your oil, and the first of the fleece of your sheep. ⁵For the LORD your God has chosen him out of all your tribes to stand to minister in the LORD's name, him and his sons forever. ⁶If a Levite comes from any of your gates out of all Israel where he lives, and comes with all the desire of his soul to the place which the LORD shall choose, ⁷then he shall minister in the name of the LORD his God, as all his brothers the Levites do, who stand there before the LORD. ⁸They shall have like portions to eat, in addition to that which comes from the sale of his family possessions. ⁹When you have come into the land which the LORD your God gives you, you shall not learn to imitate the abominations of those nations. ¹⁰There shall not be found with you anyone who makes his son or his daughter to pass through the fire, one who uses divination, one who tells fortunes, or an enchanter, or a sorcerer, ¹¹or a charmer, or someone who consults with a familiar spirit, or a wizard, or a necromancer. ¹²For whoever does these things is an abomination to the LORD. Because of these abominations, the LORD your God drives them out from before you. ¹³You shall be blameless with the LORD your God. ¹⁴For these nations that you shall dispossess listen to those who practice sorcery and to diviners; but as for you, the LORD your God has not allowed you so to do. ¹⁵The LORD your God will raise up to you a prophet from among you, of your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him. ¹⁶This is according to all that you desired of the LORD your God in Horeb in the day of the assembly, saying, "Let me not hear again the LORD my God's voice, neither let me see this great fire any more, that I not die." ¹⁷The LORD said to me, "They have well said that which they have spoken. ¹⁸I will raise them up a prophet from among their brothers, like you. I will put my words in his mouth, and he shall speak to them all that I shall command him. ¹⁹It shall happen, that whoever will not listen to my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him. ²⁰But the prophet who speaks a word presumptuously in my name, which I have not commanded him to speak, or who speaks in the name of other gods, that same prophet shall die." ²¹You may say in your heart, "How shall we know the word which the LORD has not spoken?" ²²When a prophet speaks in the LORD's name, if the thing doesn't follow, nor happen, that is the thing which the LORD has not spoken. The prophet has spoken it presumptuously. You shall not be

afraid of him.

19When the LORD your God cuts off the nations whose land the LORD your God gives you, and you succeed them and dwell in their cities and in their houses, ²you shall set apart three cities for yourselves in the middle of your land, which the LORD your God gives you to possess. ³You shall prepare the way, and divide the borders of your land which the LORD your God causes you to inherit into three parts, that every man slayer may flee there. ⁴This is the case of the man slayer who shall flee there and live: Whoever kills his neighbor unintentionally, and didn't hate him in time past—⁵as when a man goes into the forest with his neighbor to chop wood and his hand swings the ax to cut down the tree, and the head slips from the handle and hits his neighbor so that he dies—he shall flee to one of these cities and live. ⁶Otherwise, the avenger of blood might pursue the man slayer while hot anger is in his heart and overtake him, because the way is long, and strike him mortally, even though he was not worthy of death, because he didn't hate him in time past. ⁷Therefore I command you to set apart three cities for yourselves. ⁸If the LORD your God enlarges your border, as he has sworn to your fathers, and gives you all the land which he promised to give to your fathers; ⁹and if you keep all this commandment to do it, which I command you today, to love the LORD your God, and to walk ever in his ways, then you shall add three cities more for yourselves, in addition to these three. ¹⁰This is so that innocent blood will not be shed in the middle of your land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance, leaving blood guilt on you. ¹¹But if any man hates his neighbor, lies in wait for him, rises up against him, strikes him mortally so that he dies, and he flees into one of these cities; ¹²then the elders of his city shall send and bring him there, and deliver him into the hand of the avenger of blood, that he may die. ¹³Your eye shall not pity him, but you shall purge the innocent blood from Israel that it may go well with you. ¹⁴You shall not remove your neighbor's landmark, which they of old time have set, in your inheritance which you shall inherit, in the land that the LORD your God gives you to possess. ¹⁵One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin that he sins. At the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall a matter be established. ¹⁶If an unrighteous witness rises up against any man to testify against him of wrongdoing, ¹⁷then both the men, between whom the controversy is, shall stand before the LORD, before the priests and the judges who shall be in those days; ¹⁸and the judges shall make diligent inquisition; and behold, if the witness is a false witness, and has testified falsely against his brother, ¹⁹then you shall do to him as he had thought to do to his brother. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ²⁰Those who remain shall hear, and fear, and will never again commit any such evil

among you. ²¹Your eyes shall not pity: life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.

20When you go out to battle against your enemies, and see horses, chariots, and a people more numerous than you, you shall not be afraid of them; for the LORD your God, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt, is with you. ²It shall be, when you draw near to the battle, that the priest shall approach and speak to the people, ³and shall tell them, "Hear, Israel, you draw near today to battle against your enemies. Don't let your heart faint! Don't be afraid, nor tremble, neither be scared of them; ⁴for the LORD your God is he who goes with you, to fight for you against your enemies, to save you." ⁵The officers shall speak to the people, saying, "What man is there who has built a new house, and has not dedicated it? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man dedicate it. ⁶What man is there who has planted a vineyard, and has not used its fruit? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man use its fruit. ⁷What man is there who has pledged to be married to a wife, and has not taken her? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man take her." ⁸The officers shall speak further to the people, and they shall say, "What man is there who is fearful and faint-hearted? Let him go and return to his house, lest his brother's heart melt as his heart." ⁹It shall be, when the officers have finished speaking to the people, that they shall appoint captains of armies at the head of the people. ¹⁰When you draw near to a city to fight against it, then proclaim peace to it. ¹¹It shall be, if it gives you answer of peace and opens to you, then it shall be that all the people who are found therein shall become forced laborers to you, and shall serve you. ¹²If it will make no peace with you, but will make war against you, then you shall besiege it. ¹³When the LORD your God delivers it into your hand, you shall strike every male of it with the edge of the sword; ¹⁴but the women, the little ones, the livestock, and all that is in the city, even all its plunder, you shall take for plunder for yourself. You may use the plunder of your enemies, which the LORD your God has given you. ¹⁵Thus you shall do to all the cities which are very far off from you, which are not of the cities of these nations. ¹⁶But of the cities of these peoples that the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance, you shall save alive nothing that breathes; ¹⁷but you shall utterly destroy them: the Hittite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, as the LORD your God has commanded you; ¹⁸that they not teach you to follow all their abominations, which they have done for their gods; so would you sin against the LORD your God. ¹⁹When you shall besiege a city a long time, in making war against it to take it, you shall not destroy its trees by wielding an ax against them; for you may eat of them. You

shall not cut them down, for is the tree of the field man, that it should be besieged by you? ²⁰Only the trees that you know are not trees for food, you shall destroy and cut them down. You shall build bulwarks against the city that makes war with you, until it falls.

21If someone is found slain in the land which the LORD your God gives you to possess, lying in the field, and it isn't known who has struck him, ²then your elders and your judges shall come out, and they shall measure to the cities which are around him who is slain. ³It shall be that the elders of the city which is nearest to the slain man shall take a heifer of the herd, which hasn't been worked with and which has not drawn in the yoke. ⁴The elders of that city shall bring the heifer down to a valley with running water, which is neither plowed nor sown, and shall break the heifer's neck there in the valley. ⁵The priests the sons of Levi shall come near, for them the LORD your God has chosen to minister to him, and to bless in the LORD's name; and according to their word shall every controversy and every assault be decided. ⁶All the elders of that city which is nearest to the slain man shall wash their hands over the heifer whose neck was broken in the valley. ⁷They shall answer and say, "Our hands have not shed this blood, neither have our eyes seen it. ⁸Forgive, LORD, your people Israel, whom you have redeemed, and don't allow innocent blood among your people Israel." The blood shall be forgiven them. ⁹So you shall put away the innocent blood from among you, when you shall do that which is right in the LORD's eyes. ¹⁰When you go out to battle against your enemies, and the LORD your God delivers them into your hands and you carry them away captive, ¹¹and see among the captives a beautiful woman, and you are attracted to her, and desire to take her as your wife, ¹²then you shall bring her home to your house. She shall shave her head and trim her nails. ¹³She shall take off the clothing of her captivity, and shall remain in your house, and bewail her father and her mother a full month. After that you shall go in to her and be her husband, and she shall be your wife. ¹⁴It shall be, if you have no delight in her, then you shall let her go where she desires; but you shall not sell her at all for money. You shall not deal with her as a slave, because you have humbled her. ¹⁵If a man has two wives, the one beloved and the other hated, and they have borne him children, both the beloved and the hated, and if the firstborn son is hers who was hated, ¹⁶then it shall be, in the day that he causes his sons to inherit that which he has, that he may not give the son of the beloved the rights of the firstborn before the son of the hated, who is the firstborn; ¹⁷but he shall acknowledge the firstborn, the son of the hated, by giving him a double portion of all that he has; for he is the beginning of his strength. The right of the firstborn is his. ¹⁸If a man has a stubborn and rebellious son who will not obey the voice

of his father or the voice of his mother, and though they chasten him, will not listen to them, ¹⁹then his father and his mother shall take hold of him and bring him out to the elders of his city and to the gate of his place. ²⁰They shall tell the elders of his city, "This our son is stubborn and rebellious. He will not obey our voice. He is a glutton and a drunkard." ²¹All the men of his city shall stone him to death with stones. So you shall remove the evil from among you. All Israel shall hear, and fear. ²²If a man has committed a sin worthy of death, and he is put to death, and you hang him on a tree, ²³his body shall not remain all night on the tree, but you shall surely bury him the same day; for he who is hanged is accursed of God. Don't defile your land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance.

22You shall not see your brother's ox or his sheep go astray and hide yourself from them. You shall surely bring them again to your brother. ²If your brother isn't near to you, or if you don't know him, then you shall bring it home to your house, and it shall be with you until your brother comes looking for it, and you shall restore it to him. ³So you shall do with his donkey. So you shall do with his garment. So you shall do with every lost thing of your brother's, which he has lost and you have found. You may not hide yourself. ⁴You shall not see your brother's donkey or his ox fallen down by the way, and hide yourself from them. You shall surely help him to lift them up again. ⁵A woman shall not wear men's clothing, neither shall a man put on women's clothing; for whoever does these things is an abomination to the LORD your God. ⁶If you come across a bird's nest on the way, in any tree or on the ground, with young ones or eggs, and the hen sitting on the young, or on the eggs, you shall not take the hen with the young. ⁷You shall surely let the hen go, but the young you may take for yourself, that it may be well with you, and that you may prolong your days. ⁸When you build a new house, then you shall make a railing around your roof, so that you don't bring blood on your house if anyone falls from there. ⁹You shall not sow your vineyard with two kinds of seed, lest all the fruit be defiled, the seed which you have sown, and the increase of the vineyard. ¹⁰You shall not plow with an ox and a donkey together. ¹¹You shall not wear clothes of wool and linen woven together. ¹²You shall make yourselves fringes ^{viii} on the four corners of your cloak with which you cover yourself. ¹³If any man takes a wife, and goes in to her, hates her, ¹⁴accuses her of shameful things, gives her a bad name, and says, "I took this woman, and when I came near to her, I didn't find in her the tokens of virginity;" ¹⁵then the young lady's father and mother shall take and bring the tokens of the young lady's virginity to the elders of the city in the gate. ¹⁶The young lady's father shall tell the elders, "I gave my daugh-

^{viii}or, tzitziot

ter to this man as his wife, and he hates her. ¹⁷Behold, he has accused her of shameful things, saying, 'I didn't find in your daughter the tokens of virginity;' and yet these are the tokens of my daughter's virginity." They shall spread the cloth before the elders of the city. ¹⁸The elders of that city shall take the man and chastise him. ¹⁹They shall fine him one hundred shekels of silver, ^{ix} and give them to the father of the young lady, because he has given a bad name to a virgin of Israel. She shall be his wife. He may not put her away all his days. ²⁰But if this thing is true, that the tokens of virginity were not found in the young lady, ²¹then they shall bring out the young lady to the door of her father's house, and the men of her city shall stone her to death with stones, because she has done folly in Israel, to play the prostitute in her father's house. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ²²If a man is found lying with a woman married to a husband, then they shall both die, the man who lay with the woman and the woman. So you shall remove the evil from Israel. ²³If there is a young lady who is a virgin pledged to be married to a husband, and a man finds her in the city, and lies with her, ²⁴then you shall bring them both out to the gate of that city, and you shall stone them to death with stones; the lady, because she didn't cry, being in the city; and the man, because he has humbled his neighbor's wife. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ²⁵But if the man finds the lady who is pledged to be married in the field, and the man forces her and lies with her, then only the man who lay with her shall die; ²⁶but to the lady you shall do nothing. There is in the lady no sin worthy of death; for as when a man rises against his neighbor and kills him, even so is this matter; ²⁷for he found her in the field, the pledged to be married lady cried, and there was no one to save her. ²⁸If a man finds a lady who is a virgin, who is not pledged to be married, grabs her and lies with her, and they are found, ²⁹then the man who lay with her shall give to the lady's father fifty shekels ^x of silver. She shall be his wife, because he has humbled her. He may not put her away all his days. ³⁰A man shall not take his father's wife, and shall not uncover his father's skirt.

23He who is emasculated by crushing or cutting shall not enter into the LORD's assembly. ²A person born of a forbidden union shall not enter into the LORD's assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one of his enter into the LORD's assembly. ³An Ammonite or a Moabite shall not enter into the LORD's assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one belonging to them enter into the LORD's assembly forever, ⁴because they didn't meet you with bread and with water on the way when you came out of Egypt, and because they hired against you Balaam

the son of Beor from Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse you. ⁵Nevertheless the LORD your God wouldn't listen to Balaam, but the LORD your God turned the curse into a blessing to you, because the LORD your God loved you. ⁶You shall not seek their peace nor their prosperity all your days forever. ⁷You shall not abhor an Edomite, for he is your brother. You shall not abhor an Egyptian, because you lived as a foreigner in his land. ⁸The children of the third generation who are born to them may enter into the LORD's assembly. ⁹When you go out and camp against your enemies, then you shall keep yourselves from every evil thing. ¹⁰If there is among you any man who is not clean by reason of that which happens to him by night, then shall he go outside of the camp. He shall not come within the camp; ¹¹but it shall be, when evening comes, he shall bathe himself in water. When the sun is down, he shall come within the camp. ¹²You shall have a place also outside of the camp where you go relieve yourself. ¹³You shall have a trowel among your weapons. It shall be, when you relieve yourself, you shall dig with it, and shall turn back and cover your excrement; ¹⁴for the LORD your God walks in the middle of your camp, to deliver you, and to give up your enemies before you. Therefore your camp shall be holy, that he may not see an unclean thing in you, and turn away from you. ¹⁵You shall not deliver to his master a servant who has escaped from his master to you. ¹⁶He shall dwell with you, among you, in the place which he shall choose within one of your gates, where it pleases him best. You shall not oppress him. ¹⁷There shall be no prostitute of the daughters of Israel, neither shall there be a sodomite of the sons of Israel. ¹⁸You shall not bring the hire of a prostitute, or the wages of a male prostitute, ^{xi} into the house of the LORD your God for any vow; for both of these are an abomination to the LORD your God. ¹⁹You shall not lend on interest to your brother: interest of money, interest of food, interest of anything that is lent on interest. ²⁰You may charge a foreigner interest; but you shall not charge your brother interest, that the LORD your God may bless you in all that you put your hand to, in the land where you go in to possess it. ²¹When you vow a vow to the LORD your God, you shall not be slack to pay it, for the LORD your God will surely require it of you; and it would be sin in you. ²²But if you refrain from making a vow, it shall be no sin in you. ²³You shall observe and do that which has gone out of your lips. Whatever you have vowed to the LORD your God as a free will offering, which you have promised with your mouth, you must do. ²⁴When you come into your neighbor's vineyard, then you may eat your fill of grapes at your own pleasure; but you shall not put any in your container. ²⁵When you come into your neighbor's standing grain, then you may pluck the ears with your hand; but you shall not use a sickle on your neighbor's standing grain.

^{ix}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 100 shekels is about a kilogram or 2.2 pounds.

^xA shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xi}literally, dog

²⁴When a man takes a wife and marries her, then it shall be, if she finds no favor in his eyes because he has found some unseemly thing in her, that he shall write her a certificate of divorce, put it in her hand, and send her out of his house. ²When she has departed out of his house, she may go and be another man's wife. ³If the latter husband hates her, and write her a certificate of divorce, puts it in her hand, and sends her out of his house; or if the latter husband dies, who took her to be his wife; ⁴her former husband, who sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife after she is defiled; for that would be an abomination to the LORD. You shall not cause the land to sin, which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance. ⁵When a man takes a new wife, he shall not go out in the army, neither shall he be assigned any business. He shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer his wife whom he has taken. ⁶No man shall take the mill or the upper millstone as a pledge, for he takes a life in pledge. ⁷If a man is found stealing any of his brothers of the children of Israel, and he deals with him as a slave, or sells him, then that thief shall die. So you shall remove the evil from among you. ⁸Be careful in the plague of leprosy, that you observe diligently and do according to all that the Levitical priests teach you. As I commanded them, so you shall observe to do. ⁹Remember what the LORD your God did to Miriam, by the way as you came out of Egypt. ¹⁰When you lend your neighbor any kind of loan, you shall not go into his house to get his pledge. ¹¹You shall stand outside, and the man to whom you lend shall bring the pledge outside to you. ¹²If he is a poor man, you shall not sleep with his pledge. ¹³You shall surely restore to him the pledge when the sun goes down, that he may sleep in his garment and bless you. It shall be righteousness to you before the LORD your God. ¹⁴You shall not oppress a hired servant who is poor and needy, whether he is one of your brothers or one of the foreigners who are in your land within your gates. ¹⁵In his day you shall give him his wages, neither shall the sun go down on it, for he is poor and sets his heart on it, lest he cry against you to the LORD, and it be sin to you. ¹⁶The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers. Every man shall be put to death for his own sin. ¹⁷You shall not deprive the foreigner or the fatherless of justice, nor take a widow's clothing in pledge; ¹⁸but you shall remember that you were a slave in Egypt, and the LORD your God redeemed you there. Therefore I command you to do this thing. ¹⁹When you reap your harvest in your field, and have forgotten a sheaf in the field, you shall not go again to get it. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow, that the LORD your God may bless you in all the work of your hands. ²⁰When you beat your olive tree, you shall not go over the boughs again. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow. ²¹When you harvest your

vineyard, you shall not glean it after yourselves. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow. ²²You shall remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt. Therefore I command you to do this thing.

²⁵If there is a controversy between men, and they come to judgment and the judges judge them, then they shall justify the righteous and condemn the wicked. ²It shall be, if the wicked man is worthy to be beaten, that the judge shall cause him to lie down and to be beaten before his face, according to his wickedness, by number. ³He may sentence him to no more than forty stripes. He shall not give more, lest if he should give more and beat him more than that many stripes, then your brother will be degraded in your sight. ⁴You shall not muzzle the ox when he treads out the grain. ⁵If brothers dwell together, and one of them dies and has no son, the wife of the dead shall not be married outside to a stranger. Her husband's brother shall go in to her, and take her as his wife, and perform the duty of a husband's brother to her. ⁶It shall be that the firstborn whom she bears shall succeed in the name of his brother who is dead, that his name not be blotted out of Israel. ⁷If the man doesn't want to take his brother's wife, then his brother's wife shall go up to the gate to the elders, and say, "My husband's brother refuses to raise up to his brother a name in Israel. He will not perform the duty of a husband's brother to me." ⁸Then the elders of his city shall call him, and speak to him. If he stands and says, "I don't want to take her," ⁹then his brother's wife shall come to him in the presence of the elders, and loose his sandal from off his foot, and spit in his face. She shall answer and say, "So shall it be done to the man who does not build up his brother's house." ¹⁰His name shall be called in Israel, "The house of him who had his sandal removed." ¹¹When men strive against each other, and the wife of one draws near to deliver her husband out of the hand of him who strikes him, and puts out her hand, and grabs him by his private parts, ¹²then you shall cut off her hand. Your eye shall have no pity. ¹³You shall not have in your bag diverse weights, one heavy and one light. ¹⁴You shall not have in your house diverse measures, one large and one small. ¹⁵You shall have a perfect and just weight. You shall have a perfect and just measure, that your days may be long in the land which the LORD your God gives you. ¹⁶For all who do such things, all who do unrighteously, are an abomination to the LORD your God. ¹⁷Remember what Amalek did to you by the way as you came out of Egypt, ¹⁸how he met you by the way, and struck the rearmost of you, all who were feeble behind you, when you were faint and weary; and he didn't fear God. ¹⁹Therefore it shall be, when the LORD your God has given you rest from all your enemies all around, in the land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance to possess it, that you shall blot out the memory of Amalek from under the sky. You

shall not forget.

26It shall be, when you have come in to the land which the LORD your God gives you for an inheritance, possess it, and dwell in it, ²that you shall take some of the first of all the fruit of the ground, which you shall bring in from your land that the LORD your God gives you. You shall put it in a basket, and shall go to the place which the LORD your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell there. ³You shall come to the priest who shall be in those days, and tell him, “I profess today to the LORD your God, that I have come to the land which the LORD swore to our fathers to give us.” ⁴The priest shall take the basket out of your hand, and set it down before the LORD your God’s altar. ⁵You shall answer and say before the LORD your God, “My father ^{xii} was a Syrian ready to perish. He went down into Egypt, and lived there, few in number. There he became a great, mighty, and populous nation. ⁶The Egyptians mistreated us, afflicted us, and imposed hard labor on us. ⁷Then we cried to the LORD, the God of our fathers. The LORD heard our voice, and saw our affliction, our toil, and our oppression. ⁸The LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand, with an outstretched arm, with great terror, with signs, and with wonders; ⁹and he has brought us into this place, and has given us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey. ¹⁰Now, behold, I have brought the first of the fruit of the ground, which you, the LORD, have given me.” You shall set it down before the LORD your God, and worship before the LORD your God. ¹¹You shall rejoice in all the good which the LORD your God has given to you, and to your house, you, and the Levite, and the foreigner who is among you. ¹²When you have finished tithing all the tithe of your increase in the third year, which is the year of tithing, then you shall give it to the Levite, to the foreigner, to the fatherless, and to the widow, that they may eat within your gates and be filled. ¹³You shall say before the LORD your God, “I have put away the holy things out of my house, and also have given them to the Levite, to the foreigner, to the fatherless, and to the widow, according to all your commandment which you have commanded me. I have not transgressed any of your commandments, neither have I forgotten them. ¹⁴I have not eaten of it in my mourning, neither have I removed any of it while I was unclean, nor given of it for the dead. I have listened to the LORD my God’s voice. I have done according to all that you have commanded me. ¹⁵Look down from your holy habitation, from heaven, and bless your people Israel, and the ground which you have given us, as you swore to our fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey.” ¹⁶Today the LORD your God commands you to do these statutes and ordinances. You shall therefore keep and do them with all your heart and with all your soul. ¹⁷You have declared to-

day that the LORD is your God, and that you would walk in his ways, keep his statutes, his commandments, and his ordinances, and listen to his voice. ¹⁸The LORD has declared today that you are a people for his own possession, as he has promised you, and that you should keep all his commandments. ¹⁹He will make you high above all nations that he has made, in praise, in name, and in honor, and that you may be a holy people to the LORD your God, as he has spoken.

27Moses and the elders of Israel commanded the people, saying, “Keep all the commandment which I command you today. ²It shall be on the day when you shall pass over the Jordan to the land which the LORD your God gives you, that you shall set yourself up great stones, and coat them with plaster. ³You shall write on them all the words of this law, when you have passed over, that you may go in to the land which the LORD your God gives you, a land flowing with milk and honey, as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has promised you. ⁴It shall be, when you have crossed over the Jordan, that you shall set up these stones, which I command you today, on Mount Ebal, and you shall coat them with plaster. ⁵There you shall build an altar to the LORD your God, an altar of stones. You shall not use any iron tool on them. ⁶You shall build the LORD your God’s altar of uncut stones. You shall offer burnt offerings on it to the LORD your God. ⁷You shall sacrifice peace offerings, and shall eat there. You shall rejoice before the LORD your God. ⁸You shall write on the stones all the words of this law very plainly.” ⁹Moses and the Levitical priests spoke to all Israel, saying, “Be silent and listen, Israel! Today you have become the people of the LORD your God. ¹⁰You shall therefore obey the LORD your God’s voice, and do his commandments and his statutes, which I command you today.” ¹¹Moses commanded the people the same day, saying, ¹²“These shall stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people, when you have crossed over the Jordan: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin. ¹³These shall stand on Mount Ebal for the curse: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali. ¹⁴With a loud voice, the Levites shall say to all the men of Israel, ¹⁵‘Cursed is the man who makes an engraved or molten image, an abomination to the LORD, the work of the hands of the craftsman, and sets it up in secret.’ All the people shall answer and say, ‘Amen.’ ¹⁶‘Cursed is he who dishonors his father or his mother.’ All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’ ¹⁷‘Cursed is he who removes his neighbor’s landmark.’ All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’ ¹⁸‘Cursed is he who leads the blind astray on the road.’ All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’ ¹⁹‘Cursed is he who withholds justice from the foreigner, fatherless, and widow.’ All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’ ²⁰‘Cursed is he who lies with ^{xiii} his father’s wife, because he dishonors his

^{xii}or, forefather

^{xiii}i.e., has sexual relations with

father's bed.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²¹'Cursed is he who lies with any kind of animal.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²²'Cursed is he who lies with his sister, his father's daughter or his mother's daughter.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²³'Cursed is he who lies with his mother-in-law.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²⁴'Cursed is he who secretly kills his neighbor.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²⁵'Cursed is he who takes a bribe to kill an innocent person.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.' ²⁶'Cursed is he who doesn't uphold the words of this law by doing them.' All the people shall say, 'Amen.'"

28It shall happen, if you shall listen diligently to the LORD your God's voice, to observe to do all his commandments which I command you today, that the LORD your God will set you high above all the nations of the earth. ²All these blessings will come upon you, and overtake you, if you listen to the LORD your God's voice. ³You shall be blessed in the city, and you shall be blessed in the field. ⁴You shall be blessed in the fruit of your body, the fruit of your ground, the fruit of your animals, the increase of your livestock, and the young of your flock. ⁵Your basket and your kneading trough shall be blessed. ⁶You shall be blessed when you come in, and you shall be blessed when you go out. ⁷The LORD will cause your enemies who rise up against you to be struck before you. They will come out against you one way, and will flee before you seven ways. ⁸The LORD will command the blessing on you in your barns, and in all that you put your hand to. He will bless you in the land which the LORD your God gives you. ⁹The LORD will establish you for a holy people to himself, as he has sworn to you, if you shall keep the commandments of the LORD your God, and walk in his ways. ¹⁰All the peoples of the earth shall see that you are called by the LORD's name, and they will be afraid of you. ¹¹The LORD will grant you abundant prosperity in the fruit of your body, in the fruit of your livestock, and in the fruit of your ground, in the land which the LORD swore to your fathers to give you. ¹²The LORD will open to you his good treasure in the sky, to give the rain of your land in its season, and to bless all the work of your hand. You will lend to many nations, and you will not borrow. ¹³The LORD will make you the head, and not the tail. You will be above only, and you will not be beneath, if you listen to the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you today, to observe and to do, ¹⁴and shall not turn away from any of the words which I command you today, to the right hand or to the left, to go after other gods to serve them. ¹⁵But it shall come to pass, if you will not listen to the LORD your God's voice, to observe to do all his commandments and his statutes which I command you today, that all these curses will come on you and overtake you. ¹⁶You will be cursed in the city, and you will be cursed in the field. ¹⁷Your basket and your kneading trough will be

cursed. ¹⁸The fruit of your body, the fruit of your ground, the increase of your livestock, and the young of your flock will be cursed. ¹⁹You will be cursed when you come in, and you will be cursed when you go out. ²⁰The LORD will send on you cursing, confusion, and rebuke in all that you put your hand to do, until you are destroyed and until you perish quickly, because of the evil of your doings, by which you have forsaken me. ²¹The LORD will make the pestilence cling to you, until he has consumed you from off the land where you go in to possess it. ²²The LORD will strike you with consumption, with fever, with inflammation, with fiery heat, with the sword, with blight, and with mildew. They will pursue you until you perish. ²³Your sky that is over your head will be bronze, and the earth that is under you will be iron. ²⁴The LORD will make the rain of your land powder and dust. It will come down on you from the sky, until you are destroyed. ²⁵The LORD will cause you to be struck before your enemies. You will go out one way against them, and will flee seven ways before them. You will be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth. ²⁶Your dead bodies will be food to all birds of the sky, and to the animals of the earth; and there will be no one to frighten them away. ²⁷The LORD will strike you with the boils of Egypt, with the tumors, with the scurvy, and with the itch, of which you can not be healed. ²⁸The LORD will strike you with madness, with blindness, and with astonishment of heart. ²⁹You will grope at noonday, as the blind gropes in darkness, and you shall not prosper in your ways. You will only be oppressed and robbed always, and there will be no one to save you. ³⁰You will betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her. You will build a house, and you won't dwell in it. You will plant a vineyard, and not use its fruit. ³¹Your ox will be slain before your eyes, and you will not eat any of it. Your donkey will be violently taken away from before your face, and will not be restored to you. Your sheep will be given to your enemies, and you will have no one to save you. ³²Your sons and your daughters will be given to another people. Your eyes will look and fail with longing for them all day long. There will be no power in your hand. ³³A nation which you don't know will eat the fruit of your ground and all of your work. You will only be oppressed and crushed always, ³⁴so that the sights that you see with your eyes will drive you mad. ³⁵The LORD will strike you in the knees and in the legs with a sore boil, of which you cannot be healed, from the sole of your foot to the crown of your head. ³⁶The LORD will bring you, and your king whom you will set over yourselves, to a nation that you have not known, you nor your fathers. There you will serve other gods of wood and stone. ³⁷You will become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword among all the peoples where the LORD will lead you away. ³⁸You will carry much seed out into the field, and will gather little in, for the locust will consume it. ³⁹You will plant vineyards and dress them, but you

will neither drink of the wine, nor harvest, because worms will eat them. ⁴⁰You will have olive trees throughout all your borders, but you won't anoint yourself with the oil, for your olives will drop off. ⁴¹You will father sons and daughters, but they will not be yours, for they will go into captivity. ⁴²Locusts will consume all of your trees and the fruit of your ground. ⁴³The foreigner who is among you will mount up above you higher and higher, and you will come down lower and lower. ⁴⁴He will lend to you, and you won't lend to him. He will be the head, and you will be the tail. ⁴⁵All these curses will come on you, and will pursue you and overtake you, until you are destroyed, because you didn't listen to the LORD your God's voice, to keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded you. ⁴⁶They will be for a sign and for a wonder to you and to your offspring forever. ⁴⁷Because you didn't serve the LORD your God with joyfulness and with gladness of heart, by reason of the abundance of all things; ⁴⁸therefore you will serve your enemies whom the LORD sends against you, in hunger, in thirst, in nakedness, and in lack of all things. He will put an iron yoke on your neck until he has destroyed you. ⁴⁹The LORD will bring a nation against you from far away, from the end of the earth, as the eagle flies: a nation whose language you will not understand, ⁵⁰a nation of fierce facial expressions, that doesn't respect the elderly, nor show favor to the young. ⁵¹They will eat the fruit of your livestock and the fruit of your ground, until you are destroyed. They also won't leave you grain, new wine, oil, the increase of your livestock, or the young of your flock, until they have caused you to perish. ⁵²They will besiege you in all your gates until your high and fortified walls in which you trusted come down throughout all your land. They will besiege you in all your gates throughout all your land which the LORD your God has given you. ⁵³You will eat the fruit of your own body, the flesh of your sons and of your daughters, whom the LORD your God has given you, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemies will distress you. ⁵⁴The man who is tender among you, and very delicate, his eye will be evil toward his brother, toward the wife whom he loves, and toward the remnant of his children whom he has remaining, ⁵⁵so that he will not give to any of them of the flesh of his children whom he will eat, because he has nothing left to him, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy will distress you in all your gates. ⁵⁶The tender and delicate woman among you, who would not venture to set the sole of her foot on the ground for delicateness and tenderness, her eye will be evil toward the husband that she loves, toward her son, toward her daughter, ⁵⁷toward her young one who comes out from between her feet, and toward her children whom she bears; for she will eat them secretly for lack of all things in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy will distress you in your gates. ⁵⁸If you will not observe to do all the words of this law that are

written in this book, that you may fear this glorious and fearful name, THE LORD your God, ⁵⁹then the LORD will make your plagues and the plagues of your offspring fearful, even great plagues, and of long duration, and severe sicknesses, and of long duration. ⁶⁰He will bring on you again all the diseases of Egypt, which you were afraid of; and they will cling to you. ⁶¹Also every sickness and every plague which is not written in the book of this law, the LORD will bring them on you until you are destroyed. ⁶²You will be left few in number, even though you were as the stars of the sky for multitude, because you didn't listen to the LORD your God's voice. ⁶³It will happen that as the LORD rejoiced over you to do you good, and to multiply you, so the LORD will rejoice over you to cause you to perish and to destroy you. You will be plucked from the land that you are going in to possess. ⁶⁴The LORD will scatter you among all peoples, from one end of the earth to the other end of the earth. There you will serve other gods which you have not known, you nor your fathers, even wood and stone. ⁶⁵Among these nations you will find no ease, and there will be no rest for the sole of your foot; but the LORD will give you there a trembling heart, failing of eyes, and pining of soul. ⁶⁶Your life will hang in doubt before you. You will be afraid night and day, and will have no assurance of your life. ⁶⁷In the morning you will say, "I wish it were evening!" and at evening you will say, "I wish it were morning!" for the fear of your heart which you will fear, and for the sights which your eyes will see. ⁶⁸The LORD will bring you into Egypt again with ships, by the way of which I told to you that you would never see it again. There you will offer yourselves to your enemies for male and female slaves, and nobody will buy you.

29 These are the words of the covenant which the LORD commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the land of Moab, in addition to the covenant which he made with them in Horeb. ²Moses called to all Israel, and said to them: Your eyes have seen all that the LORD did in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to all his land; ³the great trials which your eyes saw, the signs, and those great wonders. ⁴But the LORD has not given you a heart to know, eyes to see, and ears to hear, to this day. ⁵I have led you forty years in the wilderness. Your clothes have not grown old on you, and your sandals have not grown old on your feet. ⁶You have not eaten bread, neither have you drunk wine or strong drink, that you may know that I am the LORD your God. ⁷When you came to this place, Sihon the king of Heshbon and Og the king of Bashan came out against us to battle, and we struck them. ⁸We took their land, and gave it for an inheritance to the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to the half-tribe of the Manassites. ⁹Therefore keep the words of this covenant and do them, that you may prosper in all that you do. ¹⁰All of you stand today in the presence of

the LORD your God: your heads, your tribes, your elders, and your officers, even all the men of Israel, ¹¹your little ones, your wives, and the foreigners who are in the middle of your camps, from the one who cuts your wood to the one who draws your water, ¹²that you may enter into the covenant of the LORD your God, and into his oath, which the LORD your God makes with you today, ¹³that he may establish you today as his people, and that he may be your God, as he spoke to you and as he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob. ¹⁴Neither do I make this covenant and this oath with you only, ¹⁵but with those who stand here with us today before the LORD our God, and also with those who are not here with us today ¹⁶(for you know how we lived in the land of Egypt, and how we came through the middle of the nations through which you passed; ¹⁷and you have seen their abominations and their idols of wood, stone, silver, and gold, which were among them); ¹⁸lest there should be among you man, woman, family, or tribe whose heart turns away today from the LORD our God, to go to serve the gods of those nations; lest there should be among you a root that produces bitter poison; ¹⁹and it happen, when he hears the words of this curse, that he bless himself in his heart, saying, “I shall have peace, though I walk in the stubbornness of my heart,” to destroy the moist with the dry. ²⁰The LORD will not pardon him, but then the LORD’s anger and his jealousy will smoke against that man, and all the curse that is written in this book will fall on him, and the LORD will blot out his name from under the sky. ²¹The LORD will set him apart for evil out of all the tribes of Israel, according to all the curses of the covenant written in this scroll of the Torah. ²²The generation to come—your children who will rise up after you, and the foreigner who will come from a far land—will say, when they see the plagues of that land, and the sicknesses with which the LORD has made it sick, ²³that all of its land is sulfur, salt, and burning, that it is not sown, doesn’t produce, nor does any grass grow in it, like the overthrow of Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in his anger, and in his wrath. ²⁴Even all the nations will say, “Why has the LORD done this to this land? What does the heat of this great anger mean?” ²⁵Then men will say, “Because they abandoned the covenant of the LORD, the God of their fathers, which he made with them when he brought them out of the land of Egypt, ²⁶and went and served other gods and worshiped them, gods that they didn’t know and that he had not given to them. ²⁷Therefore the LORD’s anger burned against this land, to bring on it all the curses that are written in this book. ²⁸The LORD rooted them out of their land in anger, in wrath, and in great indignation, and thrust them into another land, as it is today.” ²⁹The secret things belong to the LORD our God; but the things that are revealed belong to us and to our children forever, that we may do all the words of this law.

30It shall happen, when all these things have come on you, the blessing and the curse, which I have set before you, and you shall call them to mind among all the nations where the LORD your God has driven you, ²and return to the LORD your God and obey his voice according to all that I command you today, you and your children, with all your heart and with all your soul, ³that then the LORD your God will release you from captivity, have compassion on you, and will return and gather you from all the peoples where the LORD your God has scattered you. ⁴If your outcasts are in the uttermost parts of the heavens, from there the LORD your God will gather you, and from there he will bring you back. ⁵The LORD your God will bring you into the land which your fathers possessed, and you will possess it. He will do you good, and increase your numbers more than your fathers. ⁶The LORD your God will circumcise your heart, and the heart of your offspring, to love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul, that you may live. ⁷The LORD your God will put all these curses on your enemies and on those who hate you, who persecuted you. ⁸You shall return and obey the LORD’s voice, and do all his commandments which I command you today. ⁹The LORD your God will make you prosperous in all the work of your hand, in the fruit of your body, in the fruit of your livestock, and in the fruit of your ground, for good; for the LORD will again rejoice over you for good, as he rejoiced over your fathers, ¹⁰if you will obey the LORD your God’s voice, to keep his commandments and his statutes which are written in this scroll of the Torah, if you turn to the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul. ¹¹For this commandment which I command you today is not too hard for you or too distant. ¹²It is not in heaven, that you should say, “Who will go up for us to heaven, bring it to us, and proclaim it to us, that we may do it?” ¹³Neither is it beyond the sea, that you should say, “Who will go over the sea for us, bring it to us, and proclaim it to us, that we may do it?” ¹⁴But the word is very near to you, in your mouth and in your heart, that you may do it. ¹⁵Behold, I have set before you today life and prosperity, and death and evil. ¹⁶For I command you today to love the LORD your God, to walk in his ways and to keep his commandments, his statutes, and his ordinances, that you may live and multiply, and that the LORD your God may bless you in the land where you go in to possess it. ¹⁷But if your heart turns away, and you will not hear, but are drawn away and worship other gods, and serve them, ¹⁸I declare to you today that you will surely perish. You will not prolong your days in the land where you pass over the Jordan to go in to possess it. ¹⁹I call heaven and earth to witness against you today that I have set before you life and death, the blessing and the curse. Therefore choose life, that you may live, you and your descendants, ²⁰to love the LORD your God, to obey his voice, and to cling to him; for he is your life, and

the length of your days, that you may dwell in the land which the LORD swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.

31Moses went and spoke these words to all Israel. ²He said to them, "I am one hundred twenty years old today. I can no more go out and come in. The LORD has said to me, 'You shall not go over this Jordan.' ³The LORD your God himself will go over before you. He will destroy these nations from before you, and you shall dispossess them. Joshua will go over before you, as the LORD has spoken. ⁴The LORD will do to them as he did to Sihon and to Og, the kings of the Amorites, and to their land, when he destroyed them. ⁵The LORD will deliver them up before you, and you shall do to them according to all the commandment which I have commanded you. ⁶Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid or scared of them, for the LORD your God himself is who goes with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you." ⁷Moses called to Joshua, and said to him in the sight of all Israel, "Be strong and courageous, for you shall go with this people into the land which the LORD has sworn to their fathers to give them; and you shall cause them to inherit it. ⁸The LORD himself is who goes before you. He will be with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you. Don't be afraid. Don't be discouraged." ⁹Moses wrote this law and delivered it to the priests the sons of Levi, who bore the ark of the LORD's covenant, and to all the elders of Israel. ¹⁰Moses commanded them, saying, "At the end of every seven years, in the set time of the year of release, in the feast of booths, ¹¹when all Israel has come to appear before the LORD your God in the place which he will choose, you shall read this law before all Israel in their hearing. ¹²Assemble the people, the men and the women and the little ones, and the foreigners who are within your gates, that they may hear, learn, fear the LORD your God, and observe to do all the words of this law, ¹³and that their children, who have not known, may hear and learn to fear the LORD your God, as long as you live in the land where you go over the Jordan to possess it." ¹⁴The LORD said to Moses, "Behold, your days approach that you must die. Call Joshua, and present yourselves in the Tent of Meeting, that I may commission him." Moses and Joshua went, and presented themselves in the Tent of Meeting. ¹⁵The LORD appeared in the Tent in a pillar of cloud, and the pillar of cloud stood over the Tent's door. ¹⁶The LORD said to Moses, "Behold, you shall sleep with your fathers. This people will rise up and play the prostitute after the strange gods of the land where they go to be among them, and will forsake me and break my covenant which I have made with them. ¹⁷Then my anger shall be kindled against them in that day, and I will forsake them, and I will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured, and many evils and troubles shall come on them; so that they will say in that day, 'Haven't these

evils come on us because our God is not among us?' ¹⁸I will surely hide my face in that day for all the evil which they have done, in that they have turned to other gods. ¹⁹"Now therefore write this song for yourselves, and teach it to the children of Israel. Put it in their mouths, that this song may be a witness for me against the children of Israel. ²⁰For when I have brought them into the land which I swore to their fathers, flowing with milk and honey, and they have eaten and filled themselves, and grown fat, then they will turn to other gods, and serve them, and despise me, and break my covenant. ²¹It will happen, when many evils and troubles have come on them, that this song will testify before them as a witness; for it will not be forgotten out of the mouths of their descendants; for I know their ways and what they are doing today, before I have brought them into the land which I promised them." ²²So Moses wrote this song the same day, and taught it to the children of Israel. ²³He commissioned Joshua the son of Nun, and said, "Be strong and courageous; for you shall bring the children of Israel into the land which I swore to them. I will be with you." ²⁴When Moses had finished writing the words of this law in a book, until they were finished, ²⁵Moses commanded the Levites, who bore the ark of the LORD's covenant, saying, ²⁶"Take this scroll of the Torah, and put it by the side of the ark of the LORD your God's covenant, that it may be there for a witness against you. ²⁷For I know your rebellion and your stiff neck. Behold, while I am yet alive with you today, you have been rebellious against the LORD. How much more after my death? ²⁸Assemble to me all the elders of your tribes and your officers, that I may speak these words in their ears, and call heaven and earth to witness against them. ²⁹For I know that after my death you will utterly corrupt yourselves, and turn away from the way which I have commanded you; and evil will happen to you in the latter days, because you will do that which is evil in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger through the work of your hands." ³⁰Moses spoke in the ears of all the assembly of Israel the words of this song, until they were finished.

32Give ear, you heavens, and I will speak. Let the earth hear the words of my mouth. ²My doctrine will drop as the rain. My speech will condense as the dew, as the misty rain on the tender grass, as the showers on the herb. ³For I will proclaim the LORD's name. Ascribe greatness to our God! ⁴The Rock: his work is perfect, for all his ways are just. A God of faithfulness who does no wrong, just and right is he. ⁵They have dealt corruptly with him. They are not his children, because of their defect. They are a perverse and crooked generation. ⁶Is this the way you repay the LORD, foolish and unwise people? Isn't he your father who has bought you? He has made you and established you. ⁷Remember the days of old. Consider the years of many generations. Ask your father, and he will

show you; your elders, and they will tell you. ⁸When the Most High gave to the nations their inheritance, when he separated the children of men, he set the bounds of the peoples according to the number of the children of Israel. ⁹For the LORD's portion is his people. Jacob is the lot of his inheritance. ¹⁰He found him in a desert land, in the waste howling wilderness. He surrounded him. He cared for him. He kept him as the apple of his eye. ¹¹As an eagle that stirs up her nest, that flutters over her young, he spread abroad his wings, he took them, he bore them on his feathers. ¹²The LORD alone led him. There was no foreign god with him. ¹³He made him ride on the high places of the earth. He ate the increase of the field. He caused him to suck honey out of the rock, oil out of the flinty rock; ¹⁴butter from the herd, and milk from the flock, with fat of lambs, rams of the breed of Bashan, and goats, with the finest of the wheat. From the blood of the grape, you drank wine. ¹⁵But Jeshurun grew fat, and kicked. You have grown fat. You have grown thick. You have become sleek. Then he abandoned God who made him, and rejected the Rock of his salvation. ¹⁶They moved him to jealousy with strange gods. They provoked him to anger with abominations. ¹⁷They sacrificed to demons, not God, to gods that they didn't know, to new gods that came up recently, which your fathers didn't dread. ¹⁸Of the Rock who became your father, you are unmindful, and have forgotten God who gave you birth. ¹⁹The LORD saw and abhorred, because of the provocation of his sons and his daughters. ²⁰He said, "I will hide my face from them. I will see what their end will be; for they are a very perverse generation, children in whom is no faithfulness. ²¹They have moved me to jealousy with that which is not God. They have provoked me to anger with their vanities. I will move them to jealousy with those who are not a people. I will provoke them to anger with a foolish nation. ²²For a fire is kindled in my anger, that burns to the lowest Sheol, ^{xiv} devours the earth with its increase, and sets the foundations of the mountains on fire. ²³"I will heap evils on them. I will spend my arrows on them. ²⁴They shall be wasted with hunger, and devoured with burning heat and bitter destruction. I will send the teeth of animals on them, with the venom of vipers that glide in the dust. ²⁵Outside the sword will bereave, and in the rooms, terror on both young man and virgin, the nursing infant with the gray-haired man. ²⁶I said that I would scatter them afar. I would make their memory to cease from among men; ²⁷were it not that I feared the provocation of the enemy, lest their adversaries should judge wrongly, lest they should say, 'Our hand is exalted, The LORD has not done all this.'" ²⁸For they are a nation void of counsel. There is no understanding in them. ²⁹Oh that they were wise, that they understood this, that they would consider their latter end! ³⁰How could one chase a thousand, and two put

ten thousand to flight, unless their Rock had sold them, and the LORD had delivered them up? ³¹For their rock is not as our Rock, even our enemies themselves concede. ³²For their vine is of the vine of Sodom, of the fields of Gomorrah. Their grapes are poison grapes. Their clusters are bitter. ³³Their wine is the poison of serpents, the cruel venom of asps. ³⁴"Isn't this laid up in store with me, sealed up among my treasures? ³⁵Vengeance is mine, and recompense, at the time when their foot slides, for the day of their calamity is at hand. Their doom rushes at them." ³⁶For the LORD will judge his people, and have compassion on his servants, when he sees that their power is gone, that there is no one remaining, shut up or left at large. ³⁷He will say, "Where are their gods, the rock in which they took refuge, ³⁸which ate the fat of their sacrifices, and drank the wine of their drink offering? Let them rise up and help you! Let them be your protection. ³⁹"See now that I myself am he. There is no god with me. I kill and I make alive. I wound and I heal. There is no one who can deliver out of my hand. ⁴⁰For I lift up my hand to heaven and declare, as I live forever, ⁴¹if I sharpen my glittering sword, my hand grasps it in judgment; I will take vengeance on my adversaries, and will repay those who hate me. ⁴²I will make my arrows drunk with blood. My sword shall devour flesh with the blood of the slain and the captives, from the head of the leaders of the enemy." ⁴³Rejoice, you nations, with his people, for he will avenge the blood of his servants. He will take vengeance on his adversaries, and will make atonement for his land and for his people. ^{xv} ⁴⁴Moses came and spoke all the words of this song in the ears of the people, he and Joshua the son of Nun. ⁴⁵Moses finished reciting all these words to all Israel. ⁴⁶He said to them, "Set your heart to all the words which I testify to you today, which you shall command your children to observe to do, all the words of this law. ⁴⁷For it is no vain thing for you, because it is your life, and through this thing you shall prolong your days in the land, where you go over the Jordan to possess it." ⁴⁸The LORD spoke to Moses that same day, saying, ⁴⁹"Go up into this mountain of Abarim, to Mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab, that is across from Jericho; and see the land of Canaan, which I give to the children of Israel for a possession. ⁵⁰Die on the mountain where you go up, and be gathered to your people, as Aaron your brother died on Mount Hor, and was gathered to his people; ⁵¹because you trespassed against me among the children of Israel at the waters of Meribah of Kadesh, in the wilderness of Zin; because you didn't uphold my holiness among the children of Israel. ⁵²For you shall see the land from a distance;

^{xiv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xv}For this verse, LXX reads: Rejoice, you heavens, with him, and let all the angels of God worship him; rejoice you Gentiles, with his people, and let all the sons of God strengthen themselves in him; for he will avenge the blood of his sons, and he will render vengeance, and recompense justice to his enemies, and will reward them that hate him; and the Lord shall purge the land of his people.

but you shall not go there into the land which I give the children of Israel."

33This is the blessing with which Moses the man of God blessed the children of Israel before his death. ²He said, "The LORD came from Sinai, and rose from Seir to them. He shone from Mount Paran. He came from the ten thousands of holy ones. At his right hand was a fiery law for them. ^{xvi} ³Yes, he loves the people. All his holy ones are in your hand. They sat down at your feet. Each receives your words. ⁴Moses commanded us a law, an inheritance for the assembly of Jacob. ⁵He was king in Jeshurun, when the heads of the people were gathered, all the tribes of Israel together. ⁶"Let Reuben live, and not die; Nor let his men be few." ⁷This is for Judah. He said, "Hear, LORD, the voice of Judah. Bring him in to his people. With his hands he contended for himself. You shall be a help against his adversaries." ⁸About Levi he said, "Your Thummim and your Urim are with your godly one, whom you proved at Massah, with whom you contended at the waters of Meribah. ⁹He said of his father, and of his mother, 'I have not seen him.' He didn't acknowledge his brothers, nor did he know his own children; for they have observed your word, and keep your covenant. ¹⁰They shall teach Jacob your ordinances, and Israel your law. They shall put incense before you, and whole burnt offering on your altar. ¹¹LORD, bless his skills. Accept the work of his hands. Strike through the hips of those who rise up against him, of those who hate him, that they not rise again." ¹²About Benjamin he said, "The beloved of the LORD will dwell in safety by him. He covers him all day long. He dwells between his shoulders." ¹³About Joseph he said, "His land is blessed by the LORD, for the precious things of the heavens, for the dew, for the deep that couches beneath, ¹⁴for the precious things of the fruits of the sun, for the precious things that the moon can yield, ¹⁵for the best things of the ancient mountains, for the precious things of the everlasting hills, ¹⁶for the precious things of the earth and its fullness, the good will of him who lived in the bush. ^{xvii} Let this come on the head of Joseph, on the crown of the head of him who was separated from his brothers. ¹⁷Majesty belongs to the first-born of his herd. His horns are the horns of the wild ox. With them he will push all the peoples to the ends of the earth. They are the ten thousands of Ephraim. They are the thousands of Manasseh." ¹⁸About Zebulun he said, "Rejoice, Zebulun, in your going out; and Issachar, in your tents. ¹⁹They will call the peoples to the mountain. There they will offer sacrifices of righteousness, for they will draw out the abundance of the seas, the hidden treasures of the sand." ²⁰About Gad he said, "He who enlarges Gad is

blessed. He dwells as a lioness, and tears the arm and the crown of the head. ²¹He provided the first part for himself, for the lawgiver's portion was reserved for him. He came with the heads of the people. He executed the righteousness of the LORD, His ordinances with Israel." ²²About Dan he said, "Dan is a lion's cub that leaps out of Bashan." ²³About Naphtali he said, "Naphtali, satisfied with favor, full of the LORD's blessing, Possess the west and the south." ²⁴About Asher he said, "Asher is blessed with children. Let him be acceptable to his brothers. Let him dip his foot in oil. ²⁵Your bars will be iron and bronze. As your days, so your strength will be. ²⁶"There is no one like God, Jeshurun, who rides on the heavens for your help, in his excellency on the skies. ²⁷The eternal God is your dwelling place. Underneath are the everlasting arms. He thrust out the enemy from before you, and said, 'Destroy!' ²⁸Israel dwells in safety, the fountain of Jacob alone, In a land of grain and new wine. Yes, his heavens drop down dew. ²⁹You are happy, Israel! Who is like you, a people saved by the LORD, the shield of your help, the sword of your excellency? Your enemies will submit themselves to you. You will tread on their high places."

34Moses went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo, to the top of Pisgah, that is opposite Jericho. The LORD showed him all the land of Gilead to Dan, ²and all Naphtali, and the land of Ephraim and Manasseh, and all the land of Judah, to the Western Sea, ³and the south, ^{xviii} and the Plain of the valley of Jericho the city of palm trees, to Zoar. ⁴The LORD said to him, "This is the land which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, saying, 'I will give it to your offspring.' I have caused you to see it with your eyes, but you shall not go over there." ⁵So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the LORD's word. ⁶He buried him in the valley in the land of Moab opposite Beth Peor, but no man knows where his tomb is to this day. ⁷Moses was one hundred twenty years old when he died. His eye was not dim, nor his strength gone. ⁸The children of Israel wept for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days, until the days of weeping in the mourning for Moses were ended. ⁹Joshua the son of Nun was full of the spirit of wisdom, for Moses had laid his hands on him. The children of Israel listened to him, and did as the LORD commanded Moses. ¹⁰Since then, there has not arisen a prophet in Israel like Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face, ¹¹in all the signs and the wonders which the LORD sent him to do in the land of Egypt, to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to all his land, ¹²and in all the mighty hand, and in all the awesome deeds, which Moses did in the sight of all Israel.

^{xvi}another manuscript reads "He came with myriads of holy ones from the south, from his mountain slopes."

^{xviii}i.e., the burning bush of

^{xviii}or, Negev

Joshua

¹Now after the death of Moses the servant of the LORD,ⁱ the LORD spoke to Joshua the son of Nun, Moses' servant, saying, ²"Moses my servant is dead. Now therefore arise, go across this Jordan, you and all these people, to the land which I am giving to them, even to the children of Israel. ³I have given you every place that the sole of your foot will tread on, as I told Moses. ⁴From the wilderness and this Lebanon even to the great river, the river Euphrates, all the land of the Hittites, and to the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your border. ⁵No man will be able to stand before you all the days of your life. As I was with Moses, so I will be with you. I will not fail you nor forsake you. ⁶"Be strong and courageous; for you shall cause this people to inherit the land which I swore to their fathers to give them. ⁷Only be strong and very courageous. Be careful to observe to do according to all the law which Moses my servant commanded you. Don't turn from it to the right hand or to the left, that you may have good success wherever you go. ⁸This scroll of the Torah shall not depart from your mouth, but you shall meditate on it day and night, that you may observe to do according to all that is written in it; for then you shall make your way prosperous, and then you shall have good success. ⁹Haven't I commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid. Don't be dismayed, for the LORD your Godⁱⁱ is with you wherever you go." ¹⁰Then Joshua commanded the officers of the people, saying, ¹¹"Pass through the middle of the camp, and command the people, saying, 'Prepare food; for within three days you are to pass over this Jordan, to go in to possess the land which the LORD your God gives you to possess.'" ¹²Joshua spoke to the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, saying, ¹³"Remember the word which Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, saying, 'The LORD your God gives you rest, and will give you this land. ¹⁴Your wives, your little ones, and your livestock shall live in the land which Moses gave you beyond the Jordan; but you shall pass over before your brothers armed, all the mighty men of valor, and shall help them ¹⁵until the LORD has

given your brothers rest, as he has given you, and they have also possessed the land which the LORD your God gives them. Then you shall return to the land of your possession and possess it, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave you beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise.'" ¹⁶They answered Joshua, saying, "All that you have commanded us we will do, and wherever you send us we will go. ¹⁷Just as we listened to Moses in all things, so will we listen to you. Only may the LORD your God be with you, as he was with Moses. ¹⁸Whoever rebels against your commandment, and doesn't listen to your words in all that you command him shall himself be put to death. Only be strong and courageous."

²Joshua the son of Nun secretly sent two men out of Shittim as spies, saying, "Go, view the land, including Jericho." They went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab, and slept there. ²The king of Jericho was told, "Behold,ⁱⁱⁱ men of the children of Israel came in here tonight to spy out the land." ³Jericho's king sent to Rahab, saying, "Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered into your house; for they have come to spy out all the land." ⁴The woman took the two men and hid them. Then she said, "Yes, the men came to me, but I didn't know where they came from. ⁵About the time of the shutting of the gate, when it was dark, the men went out. Where the men went, I don't know. Pursue them quickly. You may catch up with them." ⁶But she had brought them up to the roof, and hidden them under the stalks of flax which she had laid in order on the roof. ⁷The men pursued them along the way to the fords of the Jordan River. As soon as those who pursued them had gone out, they shut the gate. ⁸Before they had lain down, she came up to them on the roof. ⁹She said to the men, "I know that the LORD has given you the land, and that the fear of you has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before you. ¹⁰For we have heard how the LORD dried up the water of the Sea of Suf before you, when you came out of Egypt; and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan, to Si-

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

hon and to Og, whom you utterly destroyed. ¹¹As soon as we had heard it, our hearts melted, and there wasn't any more spirit in any man, because of you: for the LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and on earth beneath. ¹²Now therefore, please swear to me by the LORD, since I have dealt kindly with you, that you also will deal kindly with my father's house, and give me a true sign; ¹³and that you will save alive my father, my mother, my brothers, and my sisters, and all that they have, and will deliver our lives from death." ¹⁴The men said to her, "Our life for yours, if you don't talk about this business of ours; and it shall be, when the LORD gives us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with you." ¹⁵Then she let them down by a cord through the window; for her house was on the side of the wall, and she lived on the wall. ¹⁶She said to them, "Go to the mountain, lest the pursuers find you. Hide yourselves there three days, until the pursuers have returned. Afterward, you may go your way." ¹⁷The men said to her, "We will be guiltless of this your oath which you've made us to swear." ¹⁸Behold, when we come into the land, tie this line of scarlet thread in the window which you used to let us down. Gather to yourself into the house your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father's household. ¹⁹It shall be that whoever goes out of the doors of your house into the street, his blood will be on his head, and we will be guiltless. Whoever is with you in the house, his blood shall be on our head, if any hand is on him. ²⁰But if you talk about this business of ours, then we shall be guiltless of your oath which you've made us to swear." ²¹She said, "Let it be as you have said." She sent them away, and they departed. Then she tied the scarlet line in the window. ²²They went and came to the mountain, and stayed there three days, until the pursuers had returned. The pursuers sought them all along the way, but didn't find them. ²³Then the two men returned, descended from the mountain, crossed the river, and came to Joshua the son of Nun. They told him all that had happened to them. ²⁴They said to Joshua, "Truly the LORD has delivered all the land into our hands. Moreover, all the inhabitants of the land melt away before us."

3Joshua got up early in the morning; and they moved from Shittim and came to the Jordan, he and all the children of Israel. They camped there before they crossed over. ²After three days, the officers went through the middle of the camp; ³and they commanded the people, saying, "When you see the ark of the LORD your God's covenant, and the Levitical priests bearing it, then leave your place and follow it. ⁴Yet there shall be a space between you and it of about two thousand cubits ^{iv} by measure—don't come closer to it—that you may know the way by which

you must go; for you have not passed this way before." ⁵Joshua said to the people, "Sanctify yourselves; for tomorrow the LORD will do wonders among you." ⁶Joshua spoke to the priests, saying, "Take up the ark of the covenant, and cross over before the people." They took up the ark of the covenant, and went before the people. ⁷The LORD said to Joshua, "Today I will begin to magnify you in the sight of all Israel, that they may know that as I was with Moses, so I will be with you." ⁸You shall command the priests who bear the ark of the covenant, saying, 'When you come to the brink of the waters of the Jordan, you shall stand still in the Jordan.'" ⁹Joshua said to the children of Israel, "Come here, and hear the words of the LORD your God." ¹⁰Joshua said, "By this you shall know that the living God is among you, and that he will without fail drive the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Hivite, the Perizzite, the Girgashite, the Amorite, and the Jebusite out from before you. ¹¹Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord ^v of all the earth passes over before you into the Jordan. ¹²Now therefore take twelve men out of the tribes of Israel, for every tribe a man. ¹³It shall be that when the soles of the feet of the priests who bear the ark of the LORD, the Lord of all the earth, rest in the waters of the Jordan, that the waters of the Jordan will be cut off. The waters that come down from above shall stand in one heap." ¹⁴When the people moved from their tents to pass over the Jordan, the priests who bore the ark of the covenant being before the people, ¹⁵and when those who bore the ark had come to the Jordan, and the feet of the priests who bore the ark had dipped in the edge of the water (for the Jordan overflows all its banks all the time of harvest), ¹⁶the waters which came down from above stood, and rose up in one heap a great way off, at Adam, the city that is beside Zarethan; and those that went down toward the sea of the Arabah, even the Salt Sea, were wholly cut off. Then the people passed over near Jericho. ¹⁷The priests who bore the ark of the LORD's covenant stood firm on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan; and all Israel crossed over on dry ground, until all the nation had passed completely over the Jordan.

4When all the nation had completely crossed over the Jordan, the LORD spoke to Joshua, saying, ²"Take twelve men out of the people, a man out of every tribe, ³and command them, saying, 'Take from out of the middle of the Jordan, out of the place where the priests' feet stood firm, twelve stones, carry them over with you, and lay them down in the place where you'll camp tonight.'" ⁴Then Joshua called the twelve men whom he had prepared of the children of Israel, a man out of every tribe. ⁵Joshua said to them, "Cross before the ark of the LORD your God into the middle of the Jordan, and each of you pick up a stone and put it on your shoulder, according to the

^{iv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters, so 2,000 cubits is about 920 meters.

^vThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

number of the tribes of the children of Israel; ⁶that this may be a sign among you, that when your children ask in the future, saying, 'What do you mean by these stones?' ⁷then you shall tell them, 'Because the waters of the Jordan were cut off before the ark of the LORD's covenant. When it crossed over the Jordan, the waters of the Jordan were cut off. These stones shall be for a memorial to the children of Israel forever.' ⁸The children of Israel did as Joshua commanded, and took up twelve stones out of the middle of the Jordan, as the LORD spoke to Joshua, according to the number of the tribes of the children of Israel. They carried them over with them to the place where they camped, and laid them down there. ⁹Joshua set up twelve stones in the middle of the Jordan, in the place where the feet of the priests who bore the ark of the covenant stood; and they are there to this day. ¹⁰For the priests who bore the ark stood in the middle of the Jordan until everything was finished that the LORD commanded Joshua to speak to the people, according to all that Moses commanded Joshua; and the people hurried and passed over. ¹¹When all the people had completely crossed over, the LORD's ark crossed over with the priests in the presence of the people. ¹²The children of Reuben, and the children of Gad, and the half-tribe of Manasseh crossed over armed before the children of Israel, as Moses spoke to them. ¹³About forty thousand men, ready and armed for war, passed over before the LORD to battle, to the plains of Jericho. ¹⁴On that day, the LORD magnified Joshua in the sight of all Israel; and they feared him, as they feared Moses, all the days of his life. ¹⁵The LORD spoke to Joshua, saying, ¹⁶"Command the priests who bear the ark of the covenant, that they come up out of the Jordan." ¹⁷Joshua therefore commanded the priests, saying, "Come up out of the Jordan!" ¹⁸When the priests who bore the ark of the LORD's covenant had come up out of the middle of the Jordan, and the soles of the priests' feet had been lifted up to the dry ground, the waters of the Jordan returned to their place, and went over all its banks, as before. ¹⁹The people came up out of the Jordan on the tenth day of the first month, and encamped in Gilgal, on the east border of Jericho. ²⁰Joshua set up those twelve stones, which they took out of the Jordan, in Gilgal. ²¹He spoke to the children of Israel, saying, "When your children ask their fathers in time to come, saying, 'What do these stones mean?' ²²Then you shall let your children know, saying, 'Israel came over this Jordan on dry land. ²³For the LORD your God dried up the waters of the Jordan from before you until you had crossed over, as the LORD your God did to the Sea of Suf, which he dried up from before us, until we had crossed over, ²⁴that all the peoples of the earth may know that the LORD's hand is mighty, and that you may fear the LORD your God forever.'"

⁵When all the kings of the Amorites, who were beyond

the Jordan westward, and all the kings of the Canaanites, who were by the sea, heard how the LORD had dried up the waters of the Jordan from before the children of Israel until we had crossed over, their heart melted, and there was no more spirit in them, because of the children of Israel. ²At that time, the LORD said to Joshua, "Make flint knives, and circumcise again the sons of Israel the second time." ³Joshua made himself flint knives, and circumcised the sons of Israel at the hill of the foreskins. ⁴This is the reason Joshua circumcised them: all the people who came out of Egypt, who were males, even all the men of war, died in the wilderness along the way, after they came out of Egypt. ⁵For all the people who came out were circumcised; but all the people who were born in the wilderness along the way as they came out of Egypt had not been circumcised. ⁶For the children of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness until all the nation, even the men of war who came out of Egypt, were consumed, because they didn't listen to the LORD's voice. The LORD swore to them that he wouldn't let them see the land which the LORD swore to their fathers that he would give us, a land flowing with milk and honey. ⁷Their children, whom he raised up in their place, were circumcised by Joshua, for they were uncircumcised, because they had not circumcised them on the way. ⁸When they were done circumcising the whole nation, they stayed in their places in the camp until they were healed. ⁹The LORD said to Joshua, "Today I have rolled away the reproach of Egypt from you." Therefore the name of that place was called Gilgal ^{vi} to this day. ¹⁰The children of Israel encamped in Gilgal. They kept the Passover on the fourteenth day of the month at evening in the plains of Jericho. ¹¹They ate unleavened cakes and parched grain of the produce of the land on the next day after the Passover, in the same day. ¹²The manna ceased on the next day, after they had eaten of the produce of the land. The children of Israel didn't have manna any more, but they ate of the fruit of the land of Canaan that year. ¹³When Joshua was by Jericho, he lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, a man stood in front of him with his sword drawn in his hand. Joshua went to him and said to him, "Are you for us, or for our enemies?" ¹⁴He said, "No; but I have come now as commander of the LORD's army." Joshua fell on his face to the earth, and worshiped, and asked him, "What does my lord say to his servant?" ¹⁵The prince of the LORD's army said to Joshua, "Take off your sandals, for the place on which you stand is holy." Joshua did so.

⁶Now Jericho was tightly shut up because of the children of Israel. No one went out, and no one came in. ²The LORD said to Joshua, "Behold, I have given Jericho into your hand, with its king and the mighty men of valor. ³All of your men of war shall march around the city,

^{vi}"Gilgal" sounds like the Hebrew for "roll."

going around the city once. You shall do this six days. ⁴Seven priests shall bear seven shofars ^{vii} or, trumpetsof rams' horns before the ark. On the seventh day, you shall march around the city seven times, and the priests shall blow the shofars ^{viii} . or, trumpets ⁵It shall be that when they make a long blast with the ram's horn, and when you hear the sound of the shofar, all the people shall shout with a great shout; then the city wall will fall down flat, and the people shall go up, every man straight in front of him." ⁶Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said to them, "Take up the ark of the covenant, and let seven priests bear seven shofars ^{ix} or, trumpetsof rams' horns before the LORD's ark." ⁷They said to the people, "Advance! March around the city, and let the armed men pass on before the LORD's ark." ⁸It was so, that when Joshua had spoken to the people, the seven priests bearing the seven shofars ^x or, trumpetsof rams' horns before the LORD advanced and blew the shofars ^{xi} , or, trumpetsand the ark of the LORD's covenant followed them. ⁹The armed men went before the priests who blew the shofars ^{xii} , or, trumpetsand the ark went after them. The shofars ^{xiii} or, trumpets sounded as they went. ¹⁰Joshua commanded the people, saying, "You shall not shout nor let your voice be heard, neither shall any word proceed out of your mouth until the day I tell you to shout. Then you shall shout." ¹¹So he caused the LORD's ark to go around the city, circling it once. Then they came into the camp, and stayed in the camp. ¹²Joshua rose early in the morning, and the priests took up the LORD's ark. ¹³The seven priests bearing the seven shofars ^{xiv} or, trumpetsof rams' horns in front of the LORD's ark went on continually, and blew the shofars ^{xv} . or, trumpetsThe armed men went in front of them. The rear guard came after the LORD's ark. The shofars ^{xvi} or, trumpets sounded as they went. ¹⁴The second day they marched around the city once, and returned into the camp. They did this six days. ¹⁵On the seventh day, they rose early at the dawning of the day, and marched around the city in the same way seven times. On this day only they marched around the city seven times. ¹⁶At the seventh time, when the priests blew the shofars ^{xvii} , or, trumpetsJoshua said to the people, "Shout, for the LORD has given you the city! ¹⁷The city shall be devoted, even it and all that is in it, to the LORD. Only Rahab the prostitute shall live, she and all who are with her in the house, because she hid the messengers that we sent. ¹⁸But

as for you, only keep yourselves from what is devoted to destruction, lest when you have devoted it, you take of the devoted thing; so you would make the camp of Israel accursed and trouble it. ¹⁹But all the silver, gold, and vessels of bronze and iron are holy to the LORD. They shall come into the LORD's treasury." ²⁰So the people shouted and the priests blew the shofars ^{xviii} . or, trumpetsWhen the people heard the sound of the shofar, the people shouted with a great shout, and the wall fell down flat, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight in front of him, and they took the city. ²¹They utterly destroyed all that was in the city, both man and woman, both young and old, and ox, sheep, and donkey, with the edge of the sword. ²²Joshua said to the two men who had spied out the land, "Go into the prostitute's house, and bring the woman and all that she has out from there, as you swore to her." ²³The young men who were spies went in, and brought out Rahab with her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had. They also brought out all of her relatives, and they set them outside of the camp of Israel. ²⁴They burned the city with fire, and all that was in it. Only they put the silver, the gold, and the vessels of bronze and of iron into the treasury of the LORD's house. ²⁵But Rahab the prostitute, her father's household, and all that she had, Joshua saved alive. She lives in the middle of Israel to this day, because she hid the messengers whom Joshua sent to spy out Jericho. ²⁶Joshua commanded them with an oath at that time, saying, "Cursed is the man before the LORD who rises up and builds this city Jericho. With the loss of his firstborn he will lay its foundation, and with the loss of his youngest son he will set up its gates." ²⁷So the LORD was with Joshua; and his fame was in all the land.

⁷But the children of Israel committed a trespass in the devoted things; for Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, took some of the devoted things. Therefore the LORD's anger burned against the children of Israel. ²Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is beside Beth Aven, on the east side of Bethel, and spoke to them, saying, "Go up and spy out the land." The men went up and spied out Ai. ³They returned to Joshua, and said to him, "Don't let all the people go up, but let about two or three thousand men go up and strike Ai. Don't make all the people to toil there, for there are only a few of them." ⁴So about three thousand men of the people went up there, and they fled before the men of Ai. ⁵The men of Ai struck about thirty-six men of them. They chased them from before the gate even to Shebarim, and struck them at the descent. The hearts of the people melted, and became like water. ⁶Joshua tore his clothes, and fell to the earth on his face before the LORD's ark until the evening, he and the elders of Israel; and they put dust on their heads. ⁷Joshua said, "Alas, Lord GOD,

^{xviii}or, trumpets.

^{vii}or, trumpets

^{viii}or, trumpets.

^{ix}or, trumpets

^xor, trumpets

^{xi}or, trumpets,

^{xii}or, trumpets,

^{xiii}or, trumpets

^{xiv}or, trumpets

^{xv}or, trumpets.

^{xvi}or, trumpets

^{xvii}or, trumpets,

why have you brought this people over the Jordan at all, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to cause us to perish? I wish that we had been content and lived beyond the Jordan! ⁸Oh, Lord, what shall I say, after Israel has turned their backs before their enemies? ⁹For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land will hear of it, and will surround us, and cut off our name from the earth. What will you do for your great name?" ¹⁰The LORD said to Joshua, "Get up! Why have you fallen on your face like that? ¹¹Israel has sinned. Yes, they have even transgressed my covenant which I commanded them. Yes, they have even taken some of the devoted things, and have also stolen, and also deceived. They have even put it among their own stuff. ¹²Therefore the children of Israel can't stand before their enemies. They turn their backs before their enemies, because they have become devoted for destruction. I will not be with you any more, unless you destroy the devoted things from among you. ¹³Get up! Sanctify the people, and say, 'Sanctify yourselves for tomorrow, for the LORD, the God of Israel, says, "There is a devoted thing among you, Israel. You cannot stand before your enemies until you take away the devoted thing from among you." ¹⁴In the morning therefore you shall be brought near by your tribes. It shall be that the tribe which the LORD selects shall come near by families. The family which the LORD selects shall come near by households. The household which the LORD selects shall come near man by man. ¹⁵It shall be, that he who is taken with the devoted thing shall be burned with fire, he and all that he has, because he has transgressed the LORD's covenant, and because he has done a disgraceful thing in Israel.'" ¹⁶So Joshua rose up early in the morning and brought Israel near by their tribes. The tribe of Judah was selected. ¹⁷He brought near the family of Judah, and he selected the family of the Zerahites. He brought near the family of the Zerahites man by man, and Zabdi was selected. ¹⁸He brought near his household man by man, and Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was selected. ¹⁹Joshua said to Achan, "My son, please give glory to the LORD, the God of Israel, and make confession to him. Tell me now what you have done! Don't hide it from me!" ²⁰Achan answered Joshua, and said, "I have truly sinned against the LORD, the God of Israel, and this is what I have done. ²¹When I saw among the plunder a beautiful Babylonian robe, two hundred shekels ^{xix} of silver, and a wedge of gold weighing fifty shekels, then I coveted them and took them. Behold, they are hidden in the ground in the middle of my tent, with the silver under it." ²²So Joshua sent messengers, and they ran to the tent. Behold, it was hidden in his tent, with the silver under it. ²³They took them from the middle of the tent, and brought them to Joshua and to all the children of Israel. They laid them down before

the LORD. ²⁴Joshua, and all Israel with him, took Achan the son of Zerah, the silver, the robe, the wedge of gold, his sons, his daughters, his cattle, his donkeys, his sheep, his tent, and all that he had; and they brought them up to the valley of Achor. ²⁵Joshua said, "Why have you troubled us? The LORD will trouble you today." All Israel stoned him with stones, and they burned them with fire and stoned them with stones. ²⁶They raised over him a great heap of stones that remains to this day. The LORD turned from the fierceness of his anger. Therefore the name of that place was called "The valley of Achor" to this day.

⁸The LORD said to Joshua, "Don't be afraid, and don't be dismayed. Take all the warriors with you, and arise, go up to Ai. Behold, I have given into your hand the king of Ai, with his people, his city, and his land. ²You shall do to Ai and her king as you did to Jericho and her king, except you shall take its goods and its livestock for yourselves. Set an ambush for the city behind it." ³So Joshua arose, with all the warriors, to go up to Ai. Joshua chose thirty thousand men, the mighty men of valor, and sent them out by night. ⁴He commanded them, saying, "Behold, you shall lie in ambush against the city, behind the city. Don't go very far from the city, but all of you be ready. ⁵I and all the people who are with me will approach the city. It shall happen, when they come out against us, as at the first, that we will flee before them. ⁶They will come out after us until we have drawn them away from the city; for they will say, 'They flee before us, like the first time.' So we will flee before them, ⁷and you shall rise up from the ambush, and take possession of the city; for the LORD your God will deliver it into your hand. ⁸It shall be, when you have seized the city, that you shall set the city on fire. You shall do this according to the LORD's word. Behold, I have commanded you." ⁹Joshua sent them out; and they went to set up the ambush, and stayed between Bethel and Ai on the west side of Ai; but Joshua stayed among the people that night. ¹⁰Joshua rose up early in the morning, mustered the people, and went up, he and the elders of Israel, before the people to Ai. ¹¹All the people, even the men of war who were with him, went up and came near, and came before the city and encamped on the north side of Ai. Now there was a valley between him and Ai. ¹²He took about five thousand men, and set them in ambush between Bethel and Ai, on the west side of the city. ¹³So they set the people, even all the army who was on the north of the city, and their ambush on the west of the city; and Joshua went that night into the middle of the valley. ¹⁴When the king of Ai saw it, they hurried and rose up early, and the men of the city went out against Israel to battle, he and all his people, at the time appointed, before the Arabah; but he didn't know that there was an ambush against him behind the city. ¹⁵Joshua and all Israel made as if they were beaten before them, and fled by the way

^{xix}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

of the wilderness. ¹⁶All the people who were in the city were called together to pursue after them. They pursued Joshua, and were drawn away from the city. ¹⁷There was not a man left in Ai or Bethel who didn't go out after Israel. They left the city open, and pursued Israel. ¹⁸The LORD said to Joshua, "Stretch out the javelin that is in your hand toward Ai, for I will give it into your hand." Joshua stretched out the javelin that was in his hand toward the city. ¹⁹The ambush arose quickly out of their place, and they ran as soon as he had stretched out his hand and entered into the city and took it. They hurried and set the city on fire. ²⁰When the men of Ai looked behind them, they saw, and behold, the smoke of the city ascended up to heaven, and they had no power to flee this way or that way. The people who fled to the wilderness turned back on the pursuers. ²¹When Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city, and that the smoke of the city ascended, then they turned back and killed the men of Ai. ²²The others came out of the city against them, so they were in the middle of Israel, some on this side, and some on that side. They struck them, so that they let none of them remain or escape. ²³They captured the king of Ai alive, and brought him to Joshua. ²⁴When Israel had finished killing all the inhabitants of Ai in the field, in the wilderness in which they pursued them, and they had all fallen by the edge of the sword until they were consumed, all Israel returned to Ai and struck it with the edge of the sword. ²⁵All that fell that day, both of men and women, were twelve thousand, even all the people of Ai. ²⁶For Joshua didn't draw back his hand, with which he stretched out the javelin, until he had utterly destroyed all the inhabitants of Ai. ²⁷Israel took for themselves only the livestock and the goods of that city, according to the LORD's word which he commanded Joshua. ²⁸So Joshua burned Ai and made it a heap forever, even a desolation, to this day. ²⁹He hanged the king of Ai on a tree until the evening. At sundown, Joshua commanded, and they took his body down from the tree and threw it at the entrance of the gate of the city, and raised a great heap of stones on it that remains to this day. ³⁰Then Joshua built an altar to the LORD, the God of Israel, on Mount Ebal, ³¹as Moses the servant of the LORD commanded the children of Israel, as it is written in the scroll of the Torah of Moses: an altar of uncut stones, on which no one had lifted up any iron. They offered burnt offerings on it to the LORD and sacrificed peace offerings. ³²He wrote there on the stones a copy of Moses' law, which he wrote in the presence of the children of Israel. ³³All Israel, with their elders, officers, and judges, stood on both sides of the ark before the Levitical priests, who carried the ark of the LORD's covenant, the foreigner as well as the native; half of them in front of Mount Gerizim, and half of them in front of Mount Ebal, as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded at the first, that they should bless

the people of Israel. ³⁴Afterward he read all the words of the law, the blessing and the curse, according to all that is written in the scroll of the Torah. ³⁵There was not a word of all that Moses commanded which Joshua didn't read before all the assembly of Israel, with the women, the little ones, and the foreigners who were among them.

⁹When all the kings who were beyond the Jordan, in the hill country, and in the lowland, and on all the shore of the great sea in front of Lebanon, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, heard of it ²they gathered themselves together to fight with Joshua and with Israel, with one accord. ³But when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done to Jericho and to Ai, ⁴they also resorted to a ruse, and went and made as if they had been ambassadors, and took old sacks on their donkeys, and old, torn-up and bound up wine skins, ⁵and old and patched sandals on their feet, and wore old garments. All the bread of their food supply was dry and moldy. ⁶They went to Joshua at the camp at Gilgal, and said to him and to the men of Israel, "We have come from a far country. Now therefore make a covenant with us." ⁷The men of Israel said to the Hivites, "What if you live among us? How could we make a covenant with you?" ⁸They said to Joshua, "We are your servants." Joshua said to them, "Who are you? Where do you come from?" ⁹They said to him, "Your servants have come from a very far country because of the name of the LORD your God; for we have heard of his fame, all that he did in Egypt, ¹⁰and all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, to Sihon king of Heshbon and to Og king of Bashan, who was at Ashtaroth. ¹¹Our elders and all the inhabitants of our country spoke to us, saying, 'Take supplies in your hand for the journey, and go to meet them. Tell them, "We are your servants. Now make a covenant with us."' ¹²This our bread we took hot for our supplies out of our houses on the day we went out to go to you; but now, behold, it is dry, and has become moldy. ¹³These wine skins, which we filled, were new; and behold, they are torn. These our garments and our sandals have become old because of the very long journey." ¹⁴The men sampled their provisions, and didn't ask counsel from the LORD's mouth. ¹⁵Joshua made peace with them, and made a covenant with them, to let them live. The princes of the congregation swore to them. ¹⁶At the end of three days after they had made a covenant with them, they heard that they were their neighbors, and that they lived among them. ¹⁷The children of Israel traveled and came to their cities on the third day. Now their cities were Gibeon, Chephirah, Beeroth, and Kiriath Jearim. ¹⁸The children of Israel didn't strike them, because the princes of the congregation had sworn to them by the LORD, the God of Israel. All the congregation murmured against the princes. ¹⁹But all the princes

said to all the congregation, "We have sworn to them by the LORD, the God of Israel. Now therefore we may not touch them." ²⁰We will do this to them, and let them live; lest wrath be on us, because of the oath which we swore to them." ²¹The princes said to them, "Let them live." So they became wood cutters and drawers of water for all the congregation, as the princes had spoken to them. ²²Joshua called for them, and he spoke to them, saying, "Why have you deceived us, saying, 'We are very far from you,' when you live among us?" ²³Now therefore you are cursed, and some of you will never fail to be slaves, both wood cutters and drawers of water for the house of my God." ²⁴They answered Joshua, and said, "Because your servants were certainly told how the LORD your God commanded his servant Moses to give you all the land, and to destroy all the inhabitants of the land from before you. Therefore we were very afraid for our lives because of you, and have done this thing." ²⁵Now, behold, we are in your hand. Do to us as it seems good and right to you to do." ²⁶He did so to them, and delivered them out of the hand of the children of Israel, so that they didn't kill them. ²⁷That day Joshua made them wood cutters and drawers of water for the congregation and for the LORD's altar to this day, in the place which he should choose.

10 Now when Adoni-Zedek king of Jerusalem heard how Joshua had taken Ai, and had utterly destroyed it; as he had done to Jericho and her king, so he had done to Ai and her king; and how the inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace with Israel, and were among them, ²they were very afraid, because Gibeon was a great city, as one of the royal cities, and because it was greater than Ai, and all its men were mighty. ³Therefore Adoni-Zedek king of Jerusalem sent to Hoham king of Hebron, Piram king of Jarmuth, Japhia king of Lachish, and Debir king of Eglon, saying, ⁴"Come up to me and help me. Let's strike Gibeon; for they have made peace with Joshua and with the children of Israel." ⁵Therefore the five kings of the Amorites, the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon, gathered themselves together and went up, they and all their armies, and encamped against Gibeon, and made war against it. ⁶The men of Gibeon sent to Joshua at the camp at Gilgal, saying, "Don't abandon your servants! Come up to us quickly and save us! Help us; for all the kings of the Amorites that dwell in the hill country have gathered together against us." ⁷So Joshua went up from Gilgal, he and the whole army with him, including all the mighty men of valor. ⁸The LORD said to Joshua, "Don't fear them, for I have delivered them into your hands. Not a man of them will stand before you." ⁹Joshua therefore came to them suddenly. He marched from Gilgal all night. ¹⁰The LORD confused them before Israel. He killed them with a great slaughter at Gibeon, and chased them by the way of the ascent of

Beth Horon, and struck them to Azekah and to Makkedah. ¹¹As they fled from before Israel, while they were at the descent of Beth Horon, the LORD hurled down great stones from the sky on them to Azekah, and they died. There were more who died from the hailstones than those whom the children of Israel killed with the sword. ¹²Then Joshua spoke to the LORD in the day when the LORD delivered up the Amorites before the children of Israel. He said in the sight of Israel, "Sun, stand still on Gibeon! You, moon, stop in the valley of Aijalon!" ¹³The sun stood still, and the moon stayed, until the nation had avenged themselves of their enemies. Isn't this written in the book of Jashar? The sun stayed in the middle of the sky, and didn't hurry to go down about a whole day. ¹⁴There was no day like that before it or after it, that the LORD listened to the voice of a man; for the LORD fought for Israel. ¹⁵Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to the camp to Gilgal. ¹⁶These five kings fled, and hid themselves in the cave at Makkedah. ¹⁷Joshua was told, saying, "The five kings have been found, hidden in the cave at Makkedah." ¹⁸Joshua said, "Roll large stones to cover the cave's entrance, and set men by it to guard them; ¹⁹but don't stay there. Pursue your enemies, and attack them from the rear. Don't allow them to enter into their cities; for the LORD your God has delivered them into your hand." ²⁰When Joshua and the children of Israel had finished killing them with a very great slaughter until they were consumed, and the remnant which remained of them had entered into the fortified cities, ²¹all the people returned to the camp to Joshua at Makkedah in peace. None moved his tongue against any of the children of Israel. ²²Then Joshua said, "Open the cave entrance, and bring those five kings out of the cave to me." ²³They did so, and brought those five kings out of the cave to him: the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon. ²⁴When they brought those kings out to Joshua, Joshua called for all the men of Israel, and said to the chiefs of the men of war who went with him, "Come near. Put your feet on the necks of these kings." They came near, and put their feet on their necks. ²⁵Joshua said to them, "Don't be afraid, nor be dismayed. Be strong and courageous, for the LORD will do this to all your enemies against whom you fight." ²⁶Afterward Joshua struck them, put them to death, and hanged them on five trees. They were hanging on the trees until the evening. ²⁷At the time of the going down of the sun, Joshua commanded, and they took them down off the trees, and threw them into the cave in which they had hidden themselves, and laid great stones on the mouth of the cave, which remain to this very day. ²⁸Joshua took Makkedah on that day, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with its king. He utterly destroyed it and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining. He did to the king of Makkedah as he had done to the king of Jericho. ²⁹Joshua passed from Makkedah, and

all Israel with him, to Libnah, and fought against Libnah.³⁰The LORD delivered it also, with its king, into the hand of Israel. He struck it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining in it. He did to its king as he had done to the king of Jericho.³¹Joshua passed from Libnah, and all Israel with him, to Lachish, and encamped against it, and fought against it.³²The LORD delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel. He took it on the second day, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with all the souls who were in it, according to all that he had done to Libnah.³³Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish; and Joshua struck him and his people, until he had left him no one remaining.³⁴Joshua passed from Lachish, and all Israel with him, to Eglon; and they encamped against it and fought against it.³⁵They took it on that day, and struck it with the edge of the sword. He utterly destroyed all the souls who were in it that day, according to all that he had done to Lachish.³⁶Joshua went up from Eglon, and all Israel with him, to Hebron; and they fought against it.³⁷They took it, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with its king and all its cities, and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining, according to all that he had done to Eglon; but he utterly destroyed it, and all the souls who were in it.³⁸Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to Debir, and fought against it.³⁹He took it, with its king and all its cities. They struck them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining. As he had done to Hebron, so he did to Debir, and to its king; as he had done also to Libnah, and to its king.⁴⁰So Joshua struck all the land, the hill country, the South, the lowland, the slopes, and all their kings. He left no one remaining, but he utterly destroyed all that breathed, as the LORD, the God of Israel, commanded.⁴¹Joshua struck them from Kadesh Barnea even to Gaza, and all the country of Goshen, even to Gibeon.⁴²Joshua took all these kings and their land at one time because the LORD, the God of Israel, fought for Israel.⁴³Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to the camp to Gilgal.

11When Jabin king of Hazor heard of it, he sent to Jobab king of Madon, to the king of Shimron, to the king of Achshaph,²and to the kings who were on the north, in the hill country, in the Arabah south of Chinneroth, in the lowland, and in the heights of Dor on the west,³to the Canaanite on the east and on the west, the Amorite, the Hittite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite in the hill country, and the Hivite under Hermon in the land of Mizpah.⁴They went out, they and all their armies with them, many people, even as the sand that is on the seashore in multitude, with very many horses and chariots.⁵All these kings met together; and they came and encamped together at the waters of Merom, to fight with Israel.⁶The LORD said to Joshua, “Don’t be afraid because of them; for tomor-

row at this time, I will deliver them up all slain before Israel. You shall hamstring their horses and burn their chariots with fire.”⁷So Joshua came suddenly, with all the warriors, against them by the waters of Merom, and attacked them.⁸The LORD delivered them into the hand of Israel, and they struck them, and chased them to great Sidon, and to Misrephoth Maim, and to the valley of Mizpah eastward. They struck them until they left them no one remaining.⁹Joshua did to them as the LORD told him. He hamstrung their horses and burned their chariots with fire.¹⁰Joshua turned back at that time, and took Hazor, and struck its king with the sword; for Hazor used to be the head of all those kingdoms.¹¹They struck all the souls who were in it with the edge of the sword, utterly destroying them. There was no one left who breathed. He burned Hazor with fire.¹²Joshua captured all the cities of those kings, with their kings, and he struck them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the LORD commanded.¹³But as for the cities that stood on their mounds, Israel burned none of them, except Hazor only. Joshua burned that.¹⁴The children of Israel took all the plunder of these cities, with the livestock, as plunder for themselves; but every man they struck with the edge of the sword, until they had destroyed them. They didn’t leave any who breathed.¹⁵As the LORD commanded Moses his servant, so Moses commanded Joshua. Joshua did so. He left nothing undone of all that the LORD commanded Moses.¹⁶So Joshua captured all that land, the hill country, all the South, all the land of Goshen, the lowland, the Arabah, the hill country of Israel, and the lowland of the same,¹⁷from Mount Hakkak, that goes up to Seir, even to Baal Gad in the valley of Lebanon under Mount Hermon. He took all their kings, struck them, and put them to death.¹⁸Joshua made war a long time with all those kings.¹⁹There was not a city that made peace with the children of Israel, except the Hivites, the inhabitants of Gibeon. They took all in battle.²⁰For it was of the LORD to harden their hearts, to come against Israel in battle, that he might utterly destroy them, that they might have no favor, but that he might destroy them, as the LORD commanded Moses.²¹Joshua came at that time, and cut off the Anakim from the hill country, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, and from all the hill country of Judah, and from all the hill country of Israel. Joshua utterly destroyed them with their cities.²²There were none of the Anakim left in the land of the children of Israel. Only in Gaza, in Gath, and in Ashdod, did some remain.²³So Joshua took the whole land, according to all that the LORD spoke to Moses; and Joshua gave it for an inheritance to Israel according to their divisions by their tribes. Then the land had rest from war.

12Now these are the kings of the land, whom the children of Israel struck, and possessed their land beyond the

Jordan toward the sunrise, from the valley of the Arnon to Mount Hermon, and all the Arabah eastward: ²Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon, and ruled from Aroer, which is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the middle of the valley, and half Gilead, even to the river Jabbok, the border of the children of Ammon; ³and the Arabah to the sea of Chinneroth, eastward, and to the sea of the Arabah, even the Salt Sea, eastward, the way to Beth Jeshimoth; and on the south, under the slopes of Pisgah: ⁴and the border of Og king of Bashan, of the remnant of the Rephaim, who lived at Ashtaroth and at Edrei, ⁵and ruled in Mount Hermon, and in Salecah, and in all Bashan, to the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites, and half Gilead, the border of Sihon king of Heshbon. ⁶Moses the servant of the LORD and the children of Israel struck them. Moses the servant of the LORD gave it for a possession to the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. ⁷These are the kings of the land whom Joshua and the children of Israel struck beyond the Jordan westward, from Baal Gad in the valley of Lebanon even to Mount Halak, that goes up to Seir. Joshua gave it to the tribes of Israel for a possession according to their divisions; ⁸in the hill country, and in the lowland, and in the Arabah, and in the slopes, and in the wilderness, and in the South; the Hittite, the Amorite, and the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite: ⁹the king of Jericho, one; the king of Ai, which is beside Bethel, one; ¹⁰the king of Jerusalem, one; the king of Hebron, one; ¹¹the king of Jarmuth, one; the king of Lachish, one; ¹²the king of Eglon, one; the king of Gezer, one; ¹³the king of Debir, one; the king of Geder, one; ¹⁴the king of Hormah, one; the king of Arad, one; ¹⁵the king of Libnah, one; the king of Adullam, one; ¹⁶the king of Makkedah, one; the king of Bethel, one; ¹⁷the king of Tappuah, one; the king of Hepher, one; ¹⁸the king of Aphek, one; the king of Lasharon, one; ¹⁹the king of Madon, one; the king of Hazor, one; ²⁰the king of Shimron Meron, one; the king of Achshaph, one; ²¹the king of Taanach, one; the king of Megiddo, one; ²²the king of Kedesh, one; the king of Jokneam in Carmel, one; ²³the king of Dor in the height of Dor, one; the king of Goiim in Gilgal, one; ²⁴the king of Tirzah, one: all the kings thirty-one.

13Now Joshua was old and well advanced in years. The LORD said to him, "You are old and advanced in years, and there remains yet very much land to be possessed. ²"This is the land that still remains: all the regions of the Philistines, and all the Geshurites; ³from the Shihor, which is before Egypt, even to the border of Ekron northward, which is counted as Canaanite; the five lords of the Philistines; the Gazites, and the Ashdodites, the Ashkelonites, the Gittites, and the Ekronites; also the Avvim, ⁴on the south; all the land of the Canaanites, and Mearah that belongs to the Sidonians, to Aphek, to the border of the

Amorites; ⁵and the land of the Gebalites, and all Lebanon, toward the sunrise, from Baal Gad under Mount Hermon to the entrance of Hamath; ⁶all the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim, even all the Sidonians. I will drive them out from before the children of Israel. Just allocate it to Israel for an inheritance, as I have commanded you. ⁷Now therefore divide this land for an inheritance to the nine tribes and the half-tribe of Manasseh." ⁸With him the Reubenites and the Gadites received their inheritance, which Moses gave them, beyond the Jordan eastward, even as Moses the servant of the LORD gave them: ⁹from Aroer, that is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain of Medeba to Dibon; ¹⁰and all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, to the border of the children of Ammon; ¹¹and Gilead, and the border of the Geshurites and Maacathites, and all Mount Hermon, and all Bashan to Salecah; ¹²all the kingdom of Og in Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei (who was left of the remnant of the Rephaim); for Moses attacked these, and drove them out. ¹³Nevertheless the children of Israel didn't drive out the Geshurites, nor the Maacathites: but Geshur and Maacath live within Israel to this day. ¹⁴Only he gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. The offerings of the LORD, the God of Israel, made by fire are his inheritance, as he spoke to him. ¹⁵Moses gave to the tribe of the children of Reuben according to their families. ¹⁶Their border was from Aroer, that is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain by Medeba; ¹⁷Heshbon, and all its cities that are in the plain; Dibon, Bamoth Baal, Beth Baal Meon, ¹⁸Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath, ¹⁹Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth Shagar in the mount of the valley, ²⁰Beth Peor, the slopes of Pisgah, Beth Jeshimoth, ²¹all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses struck with the chiefs of Midian, Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the princes of Sihon, who lived in the land. ²²The children of Israel also killed Balaam the son of Beor, the soothsayer, with the sword, among the rest of their slain. ²³The border of the children of Reuben was the bank of the Jordan. This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben according to their families, the cities and its villages. ²⁴Moses gave to the tribe of Gad, to the children of Gad, according to their families. ²⁵Their border was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the children of Ammon, to Aroer that is near Rabbah; ²⁶and from Heshbon to Ramath Mizpeh, and Betonim; and from Mahanaim to the border of Debir; ²⁷and in the valley, Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, the Jordan's bank, to the uttermost part of the sea of Chinnereth beyond the Jordan eastward. ²⁸This is the inheritance of the children of Gad according to their families,

the cities and its villages. ²⁹Moses gave an inheritance to the half-tribe of Manasseh. It was for the half-tribe of the children of Manasseh according to their families. ³⁰Their border was from Mahanaim, all Bashan, all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the villages of Jair, which are in Bashan, sixty cities. ³¹Half Gilead, Ashtaroth, and Edrei, the cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan, were for the children of Machir the son of Manasseh, even for the half of the children of Machir according to their families. ³²These are the inheritances which Moses distributed in the plains of Moab, beyond the Jordan at Jericho, eastward. ³³But Moses gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. The LORD, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, as he spoke to them.

¹⁴These are the inheritances which the children of Israel took in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the children of Israel, distributed to them, ²by the lot of their inheritance, as the LORD commanded by Moses, for the nine tribes, and for the half-tribe. ³For Moses had given the inheritance of the two tribes and the half-tribe beyond the Jordan; but to the Levites he gave no inheritance among them. ⁴For the children of Joseph were two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim. They gave no portion to the Levites in the land, except cities to dwell in, with their pasture lands for their livestock and for their property. ⁵The children of Israel did as the LORD commanded Moses, and they divided the land. ⁶Then the children of Judah came near to Joshua in Gilgal. Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him, "You know the thing that the LORD spoke to Moses the man of God concerning me and concerning you in Kadesh Barnea. ⁷I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to spy out the land. I brought him word again as it was in my heart. ⁸Nevertheless, my brothers who went up with me made the heart of the people melt; but I wholly followed the LORD my God. ⁹Moses swore on that day, saying, 'Surely the land where you walked shall be an inheritance to you and to your children forever, because you have wholly followed the LORD my God.' ¹⁰"Now, behold, the LORD has kept me alive, as he spoke, these forty-five years, from the time that the LORD spoke this word to Moses, while Israel walked in the wilderness. Now, behold, I am eighty-five years old, today. ¹¹As yet I am as strong today as I was in the day that Moses sent me. As my strength was then, even so is my strength now for war, to go out and to come in. ¹²Now therefore give me this hill country, of which the LORD spoke in that day; for you heard in that day how the Anakim were there, and great and fortified cities. It may be that the LORD will be with me, and I shall drive them out, as the LORD said." ¹³Joshua blessed him; and he gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for an inheritance. ¹⁴Therefore Hebron

became the inheritance of Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite to this day, because he followed the LORD, the God of Israel wholeheartedly. ¹⁵Now the name of Hebron before was Kiriath Arba, after the greatest man among the Anakim. Then the land had rest from war.

¹⁵The lot for the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families was to the border of Edom, even to the wilderness of Zin southward, at the uttermost part of the south. ²Their south border was from the uttermost part of the Salt Sea, from the bay that looks southward; ³and it went out southward of the ascent of Akrabbim, and passed along to Zin, and went up by the south of Kadesh Barnea, and passed along by Hezron, went up to Addar, and turned toward Karka; ⁴and it passed along to Azmon, went out at the brook of Egypt; and the border ended at the sea. This shall be your south border. ⁵The east border was the Salt Sea, even to the end of the Jordan. The border of the north quarter was from the bay of the sea at the end of the Jordan. ⁶The border went up to Beth Hoglah, and passed along by the north of Beth Arabah; and the border went up to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben. ⁷The border went up to Debir from the valley of Achor, and so northward, looking toward Gilgal, that faces the ascent of Adummim, which is on the south side of the river. The border passed along to the waters of En Shemesh, and ended at En Rogel. ⁸The border went up by the valley of the son of Hinnom to the side of the Jebusite (also called Jerusalem) southward; and the border went up to the top of the mountain that lies before the valley of Hinnom westward, which is at the farthest part of the valley of Rephaim northward. ⁹The border extended from the top of the mountain to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah, and went out to the cities of Mount Ephron; and the border extended to Baalah (also called Kiriath Jearim); ¹⁰and the border turned about from Baalah westward to Mount Seir, and passed along to the side of Mount Jearim (also called Chesalon) on the north, and went down to Beth Shemesh, and passed along by Timnah; ¹¹and the border went out to the side of Ekron northward; and the border extended to Shikkeron, and passed along to Mount Baalah, and went out at Jabneel; and the goings out of the border were at the sea. ¹²The west border was to the shore of the great sea. This is the border of the children of Judah according to their families. ¹³He gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh a portion among the children of Judah, according to the commandment of the LORD to Joshua, even Kiriath Arba, named after the father of Anak (also called Hebron). ¹⁴Caleb drove out the three sons of Anak: Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmai, the children of Anak. ¹⁵He went up against the inhabitants of Debir: now the name of Debir before was Kiriath Sepher. ¹⁶Caleb said, "He who strikes Kiriath Sepher, and takes it, to him I will give Achsah my daughter as wife." ¹⁷Othniel the son of Ke-

naz, the brother of Caleb, took it: and he gave him Achsah his daughter as wife. ¹⁸When she came, she had him ask her father for a field. She got off her donkey, and Caleb said, "What do you want?" ¹⁹She said, "Give me a blessing. Because you have set me in the land of the South, give me also springs of water." So he gave her the upper springs and the lower springs. ²⁰This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families. ²¹The farthest cities of the tribe of the children of Judah toward the border of Edom in the South were Kabzeel, Eder, Jagur, ²²Kinah, Dimonah, Adadah, ²³Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan, ²⁴Ziph, Telem, Bealoth, ²⁵Hazor Hadattah, Keriath Hezron (also called Hazor), ²⁶Amam, Shema, Moladah, ²⁷Hazar Gaddah, Heshmon, Beth Pelet, ²⁸Hazar Shual, Beersheba, Biziothiah, ²⁹Baalath, Iim, Ezem, ³⁰Eltolad, Chesil, Hormah, ³¹Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah, ³²Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, and Rimmon. All the cities are twenty-nine, with their villages. ³³In the lowland, Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah, ³⁴Zanoah, En Gannim, Tappuah, Enam, ³⁵Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah, ³⁶Shaaraim, Adithaim and Gedera (or Gederothaim); fourteen cities with their villages. ³⁷Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal Gad, ³⁸Dilean, Mizpah, Joktheel, ³⁹Lachish, Bozkath, Eglon, ⁴⁰Cabbon, Lahmam, Chitlish, ⁴¹Gederath, Beth Dagon, Naamah, and Makkedah; sixteen cities with their villages. ⁴²Libnah, Ether, Ashan, ⁴³Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib, ⁴⁴Keilah, Achzib, and Mareshah; nine cities with their villages. ⁴⁵Ekron, with its towns and its villages; ⁴⁶from Ekron even to the sea, all that were by the side of Ashdod, with their villages. ⁴⁷Ashdod, its towns and its villages; Gaza, its towns and its villages; to the brook of Egypt, and the great sea with its coastline. ⁴⁸In the hill country, Shamir, Jattir, Socoh, ⁴⁹Dannah, Kiriath Sannah (which is Debir), ⁵⁰Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim, ⁵¹Goshen, Holon, and Giloh; eleven cities with their villages. ⁵²Arab, Dumah, Eshan, ⁵³Janim, Beth Tappuah, Aphekah, ⁵⁴Huntah, Kiriath Arba (also called Hebron), and Zior; nine cities with their villages. ⁵⁵Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Jutah, ⁵⁶Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah, ⁵⁷Kain, Gibeah, and Timnah; ten cities with their villages. ⁵⁸Halhul, Beth Zur, Gedor, ⁵⁹Maarath, Beth Anoth, and Eltekon; six cities with their villages. ⁶⁰Kiriath Baal (also called Kiriath Jearim), and Rabbah; two cities with their villages. ⁶¹In the wilderness, Beth Arabah, Middin, Secacah, ⁶²Nibshan, the City of Salt, and En Gedi; six cities with their villages. ⁶³As for the Jebusites, the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the children of Judah couldn't drive them out; but the Jebusites live with the children of Judah at Jerusalem to this day.

16 The lot came out for the children of Joseph from the Jordan at Jericho, at the waters of Jericho on the east, even the wilderness, going up from Jericho through the hill country to Bethel. ²It went out from Bethel to Luz, and passed along to the border of the Archites to Ataroth; ³and

it went down westward to the border of the Japhletites, to the border of Beth Horon the lower, and on to Gezer; and ended at the sea. ⁴The children of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, took their inheritance. ⁵This was the border of the children of Ephraim according to their families. The border of their inheritance eastward was Ataroth Addar, to Beth Horon the upper. ⁶The border went out westward at Michmethath on the north. The border turned about eastward to Taanath Shiloh, and passed along it on the east of Janoah. ⁷It went down from Janoah to Ataroth, to Naarah, reached to Jericho, and went out at the Jordan. ⁸From Tappuah the border went along westward to the brook of Kanah; and ended at the sea. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Ephraim according to their families; ⁹together with the cities which were set apart for the children of Ephraim in the middle of the inheritance of the children of Manasseh, all the cities with their villages. ¹⁰They didn't drive out the Canaanites who lived in Gezer; but the Canaanites dwell in the territory of Ephraim to this day, and have become servants to do forced labor.

17 This was the lot for the tribe of Manasseh, for he was the firstborn of Joseph. As for Machir the firstborn of Manasseh, the father of Gilead, because he was a man of war, therefore he had Gilead and Bashan. ²So this was for the rest of the children of Manasseh according to their families: for the children of Abiezer, for the children of Helek, for the children of Asriel, for the children of Shechem, for the children of Hephher, and for the children of Shemida. These were the male children of Manasseh the son of Joseph according to their families. ³But Zelophehad, the son of Hephher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, had no sons, but daughters. These are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. ⁴They came to Eleazar the priest, and to Joshua the son of Nun, and to the princes, saying, "The LORD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance among our brothers." Therefore according to the commandment of the LORD he gave them an inheritance among the brothers of their father. ⁵Ten parts fell to Manasseh, in addition to the land of Gilead and Bashan, which is beyond the Jordan; ⁶because the daughters of Manasseh had an inheritance among his sons. The land of Gilead belonged to the rest of the sons of Manasseh. ⁷The border of Manasseh was from Asher to Michmethath, which is before Shechem. The border went along to the right hand, to the inhabitants of En Tappuah. ⁸The land of Tappuah belonged to Manasseh; but Tappuah on the border of Manasseh belonged to the children of Ephraim. ⁹The border went down to the brook of Kanah, southward of the brook. These cities belonged to Ephraim among the cities of Manasseh. The border of Manasseh was on the north side of the brook, and ended at the sea. ¹⁰Southward it was

Ephraim's, and northward it was Manasseh's, and the sea was his border. They reached to Asher on the north, and to Issachar on the east. ¹¹Manasseh had three heights in Issachar, in Asher Beth Shean and its towns, and Ibleam and its towns, and the inhabitants of Dor and its towns, and the inhabitants of Endor and its towns, and the inhabitants of Taanach and its towns, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and its towns. ¹²Yet the children of Manasseh couldn't drive out the inhabitants of those cities; but the Canaanites would dwell in that land. ¹³When the children of Israel had grown strong, they put the Canaanites to forced labor, and didn't utterly drive them out. ¹⁴The children of Joseph spoke to Joshua, saying, "Why have you given me just one lot and one part for an inheritance, since we are a numerous people, because the LORD has blessed us so far?" ¹⁵Joshua said to them, "If you are a numerous people, go up to the forest, and clear land for yourself there in the land of the Perizzites and of the Rephaim, since the hill country of Ephraim is too narrow for you." ¹⁶The children of Joseph said, "The hill country is not enough for us. All the Canaanites who dwell in the land of the valley have chariots of iron, both those who are in Beth Shean and its towns, and those who are in the valley of Jezreel." ¹⁷Joshua spoke to the house of Joseph, that is, to Ephraim and to Manasseh, saying, "You are a numerous people, and have great power. You shall not have one lot only; ¹⁸but the hill country shall be yours. Although it is a forest, you shall cut it down, and it's farthest extent shall be yours; for you shall drive out the Canaanites, though they have chariots of iron, and though they are strong."

¹⁸The whole congregation of the children of Israel assembled themselves together at Shiloh, and set up the Tent of Meeting there. The land was subdued before them. ²Seven tribes remained among the children of Israel, which had not yet divided their inheritance. ³Joshua said to the children of Israel, "How long will you neglect to go in to possess the land, which the LORD, the God of your fathers, has given you? ⁴Appoint for yourselves three men from each tribe. I will send them, and they shall arise, walk through the land, and describe it according to their inheritance; then they shall come to me. ⁵They shall divide it into seven portions. Judah shall live in his borders on the south, and the house of Joseph shall live in their borders on the north. ⁶You shall survey the land into seven parts, and bring the description here to me; and I will cast lots for you here before the LORD our God. ⁷However, the Levites have no portion among you; for the priesthood of the LORD is their inheritance. Gad, Reuben, and the half-tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance east of the Jordan, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave them." ⁸The men arose and went. Joshua commanded those who went to survey the land, saying, "Go walk through the land, survey it, and come again to me.

I will cast lots for you here before the LORD in Shiloh." ⁹The men went and passed through the land, and surveyed it by cities into seven portions in a book. They came to Joshua to the camp at Shiloh. ¹⁰Joshua cast lots for them in Shiloh before the LORD. There Joshua divided the land to the children of Israel according to their divisions. ¹¹The lot of the tribe of the children of Benjamin came up according to their families. The border of their lot went out between the children of Judah and the children of Joseph. ¹²Their border on the north quarter was from the Jordan. The border went up to the side of Jericho on the north, and went up through the hill country westward. It ended at the wilderness of Beth Aven. ¹³The border passed along from there to Luz, to the side of Luz (also called Bethel), southward. The border went down to Ataroth Addar, by the mountain that lies on the south of Beth Horon the lower. ¹⁴The border extended, and turned around on the west quarter southward, from the mountain that lies before Beth Horon southward; and ended at Kiriath Baal (also called Kiriath Jearim), a city of the children of Judah. This was the west quarter. ¹⁵The south quarter was from the farthest part of Kiriath Jearim. The border went out westward, and went out to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah. ¹⁶The border went down to the farthest part of the mountain that lies before the valley of the son of Hinnom, which is in the valley of Rephaim northward. It went down to the valley of Hinnom, to the side of the Jebusite southward, and went down to En Rogel. ¹⁷It extended northward, went out at En Shemesh, and went out to Geliloth, which is opposite the ascent of Adummim. It went down to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben. ¹⁸It passed along to the side opposite the Arabah northward, and went down to the Arabah. ¹⁹The border passed along to the side of Beth Hoglah northward; and the border ended at the north bay of the Salt Sea, at the south end of the Jordan. This was the south border. ²⁰The Jordan was its border on the east quarter. This was the inheritance of the children of Benjamin, by the borders around it, according to their families. ²¹Now the cities of the tribe of the children of Benjamin according to their families were Jericho, Beth Hoglah, Emek Keziz, ²²Beth Arabah, Zemaraim, Bethel, ²³Avvim, Parah, Ophrah, ²⁴Chephar Ammoni, Ophni, and Geba; twelve cities with their villages. ²⁵Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth, ²⁶Mizpeh, Chephirah, Mozah, ²⁷Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah, ²⁸Zelah, Eleph, the Jebusite (also called Jerusalem), Gibeath, and Kiriath; fourteen cities with their villages. This is the inheritance of the children of Benjamin according to their families.

¹⁹The second lot came out for Simeon, even for the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families. Their inheritance was in the middle of the inheritance of the children of Judah. ²They had for their inheritance Beersheba (or Sheba), Moladah, ³Hazar Shual,

Balah, Ezem, ⁴Eltolad, Bethul, Hormah, ⁵Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susah, ⁶Beth Lebaath, and Sharuhem; thirteen cities with their villages; ⁷Ain, Rimmon, Ether, and Ashan; four cities with their villages; ⁸and all the villages that were around these cities to Baalath Beer, Ramah of the South. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Simeon according to their families. ⁹Out of the part of the children of Judah was the inheritance of the children of Simeon; for the portion of the children of Judah was too much for them. Therefore the children of Simeon had inheritance in the middle of their inheritance. ¹⁰The third lot came up for the children of Zebulun according to their families. The border of their inheritance was to Sarid. ¹¹Their border went up westward, even to Maralah, and reached to Dabbesheth. It reached to the brook that is before Jokneam. ¹²It turned from Sarid eastward toward the sunrise to the border of Chisloth Tabor. It went out to Daberath, and went up to Japhia. ¹³From there it passed along eastward to Gath Hepher, to Ethkazin; and it went out at Rimmon which stretches to Neah. ¹⁴The border turned around it on the north to Hannathon; and it ended at the valley of Iphtah El; ¹⁵Kattath, Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah, and Bethlehem: twelve cities with their villages. ¹⁶This is the inheritance of the children of Zebulun according to their families, these cities with their villages. ¹⁷The fourth lot came out for Issachar, even for the children of Issachar according to their families. ¹⁸Their border was to Jezreel, Chesulloth, Shunem, ¹⁹Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath, ²⁰Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez, ²¹Remeth, Engannim, En Haddah, and Beth Pазzez. ²²The border reached to Tabor, Shahazumah, and Beth Shemesh. Their border ended at the Jordan: sixteen cities with their villages. ²³This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Issachar according to their families, the cities with their villages. ²⁴The fifth lot came out for the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families. ²⁵Their border was Helkath, Hali, Beten, Achshaph, ²⁶Allammelech, Amad, Mishal. It reached to Carmel westward, and to Shihorlibnath. ²⁷It turned toward the sunrise to Beth Dagon, and reached to Zebulun, and to the valley of Iphtah El northward to Beth Emek and Neiel. It went out to Cabul on the left hand, ²⁸and Ebron, Rehob, Hammon, and Kanah, even to great Sidon. ²⁹The border turned to Ramah, to the fortified city of Tyre; and the border turned to Hosah. It ended at the sea by the region of Achzib; ³⁰Ummah also, and Aphek, and Rehob: twenty-two cities with their villages. ³¹This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families, these cities with their villages. ³²The sixth lot came out for the children of Naphtali, even for the children of Naphtali according to their families. ³³Their border was from Heleph, from the oak in Zaanannim, Adami-nekeb, and Jabneel, to Lakkum. It ended at the Jordan. ³⁴The border turned westward to Aznoth Tabor, and went

out from there to Hukkok. It reached to Zebulun on the south, and reached to Asher on the west, and to Judah at the Jordan toward the sunrise. ³⁵The fortified cities were Ziddim, Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, Chinnereth, ³⁶Adamah, Ramah, Hazor, ³⁷Kedesh, Edrei, En Hazor, ³⁸Iron, Migdal El, Horem, Beth Anath, and Beth Shemesh; nineteen cities with their villages. ³⁹This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Naphtali according to their families, the cities with their villages. ⁴⁰The seventh lot came out for the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families. ⁴¹The border of their inheritance was Zorah, Eshtaol, Irshemesh, ⁴²Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah, ⁴³Elon, Timnah, Ekron, ⁴⁴Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath, ⁴⁵Jehud, Bene Berak, Gath Rimmon, ⁴⁶Me Jarkon, and Rakkon, with the border opposite Joppa. ⁴⁷The border of the children of Dan went out beyond them; for the children of Dan went up and fought against Leshem, and took it, and struck it with the edge of the sword, and possessed it, and lived therein, and called Leshem, Dan, after the name of Dan their forefather. ⁴⁸This is the inheritance of the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families, these cities with their villages. ⁴⁹So they finished distributing the land for inheritance by its borders. The children of Israel gave an inheritance to Joshua the son of Nun among them. ⁵⁰According to the LORD's commandment, they gave him the city which he asked, even Timnathserah in the hill country of Ephraim; and he built the city, and lived there. ⁵¹These are the inheritances, which Eleazar the priest, Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the children of Israel, distributed for inheritance by lot in Shiloh before the LORD, at the door of the Tent of Meeting. So they finished dividing the land.

20The LORD spoke to Joshua, saying, ²"Speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'Assign the cities of refuge, of which I spoke to you by Moses, ³that the man slayer who kills any person accidentally or unintentionally may flee there. They shall be to you for a refuge from the avenger of blood. ⁴He shall flee to one of those cities, and shall stand at the entrance of the gate of the city, and declare his case in the ears of the elders of that city. They shall take him into the city with them, and give him a place, that he may live among them. ⁵If the avenger of blood pursues him, then they shall not deliver up the man slayer into his hand; because he struck his neighbor unintentionally, and didn't hate him before. ⁶He shall dwell in that city until he stands before the congregation for judgment, until the death of the high priest that shall be in those days. Then the man slayer shall return, and come to his own city, and to his own house, to the city he fled from.'"⁷ They set apart Kedesh in Galilee in the hill country of Naphtali, Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim, and Kiriath Arba (also called Hebron) in the hill country of Judah. ⁸Beyond

the Jordan at Jericho eastward, they assigned Bezer in the wilderness in the plain out of the tribe of Reuben, Ramoth in Gilead out of the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan out of the tribe of Manasseh. ⁹These were the appointed cities for all the children of Israel, and for the alien who lives among them, that whoever kills any person unintentionally might flee there, and not die by the hand of the avenger of blood, until he stands trial before the congregation.

21Then the heads of fathers' houses of the Levites came near to Eleazar the priest, and to Joshua the son of Nun, and to the heads of fathers' houses of the tribes of the children of Israel. ²They spoke to them at Shiloh in the land of Canaan, saying, "The LORD commanded through Moses to give us cities to dwell in, with their pasture lands for our livestock." ³The children of Israel gave to the Levites out of their inheritance, according to the commandment of the LORD, these cities with their pasture lands. ⁴The lot came out for the families of the Kohathites. The children of Aaron the priest, who were of the Levites, had thirteen cities by lot out of the tribe of Judah, out of the tribe of the Simeonites, and out of the tribe of Benjamin. ⁵The rest of the children of Kohath had ten cities by lot out of the families of the tribe of Ephraim, out of the tribe of Dan, and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh. ⁶The children of Gershon had thirteen cities by lot out of the families of the tribe of Issachar, out of the tribe of Asher, out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh in Bashan. ⁷The children of Merari according to their families had twelve cities out of the tribe of Reuben, out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun. ⁸The children of Israel gave these cities with their pasture lands by lot to the Levites, as the LORD commanded by Moses. ⁹They gave out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, these cities which are mentioned by name: ¹⁰and they were for the children of Aaron, of the families of the Kohathites, who were of the children of Levi; for theirs was the first lot. ¹¹They gave them Kiriath Arba, named after the father of Anak (also called Hebron), in the hill country of Judah, with its pasture lands around it. ¹²But they gave the fields of the city and its villages to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for his possession. ¹³To the children of Aaron the priest they gave Hebron with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, Libnah with its pasture lands, ¹⁴Jattir with its pasture lands, Eshtemoa with its pasture lands, ¹⁵Holon with its pasture lands, Debir with its pasture lands, ¹⁶Ain with its pasture lands, Juttah with its pasture lands, and Beth Shemesh with its pasture lands: nine cities out of those two tribes. ¹⁷Out of the tribe of Benjamin, Gibeon with its pasture lands, Geba with its pasture lands, ¹⁸Anathoth with its pasture lands, and Almon with its pasture lands: four cities. ¹⁹All the cities of the children of Aaron, the priests, were thirteen cities

with their pasture lands. ²⁰The families of the children of Kohath, the Levites, even the rest of the children of Kohath, had the cities of their lot out of the tribe of Ephraim. ²¹They gave them Shechem with its pasture lands in the hill country of Ephraim, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Gezer with its pasture lands, ²²Kibzaim with its pasture lands, and Beth Horon with its pasture lands: four cities. ²³Out of the tribe of Dan, Elteke with its pasture lands, Gibbethon with its pasture lands, ²⁴Aijalon with its pasture lands, Gath Rimmon with its pasture lands: four cities. ²⁵Out of the half-tribe of Manasseh, Taanach with its pasture lands, and Gath Rimmon with its pasture lands: two cities. ²⁶All the cities of the families of the rest of the children of Kohath were ten with their pasture lands. ²⁷They gave to the children of Gershon, of the families of the Levites, out of the half-tribe of Manasseh Golan in Bashan with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Be Eshterah with its pasture lands: two cities. ²⁸Out of the tribe of Issachar, Kishion with its pasture lands, Daberath with its pasture lands, ²⁹Jarmuth with its pasture lands, En Gannim with its pasture lands: four cities. ³⁰Out of the tribe of Asher, Mishal with its pasture lands, Abdon with its pasture lands, ³¹Helkath with its pasture lands, and Rehob with its pasture lands: four cities. ³²Out of the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, Hammothdor with its pasture lands, and Kartan with its pasture lands: three cities. ³³All the cities of the Gershonites according to their families were thirteen cities with their pasture lands. ³⁴To the families of the children of Merari, the rest of the Levites, out of the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam with its pasture lands, Kartah with its pasture lands, ³⁵Dimnah with its pasture lands, and Nahalal with its pasture lands: four cities. ³⁶Out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer with its pasture lands, Jahaz with its pasture lands, ³⁷Kedemoth with its pasture lands, and Mephaath with its pasture lands: four cities. ³⁸Out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Mahanaim with its pasture lands, ³⁹Heshbon with its pasture lands, Jazer with its pasture lands: four cities in all. ⁴⁰All these were the cities of the children of Merari according to their families, even the rest of the families of the Levites. Their lot was twelve cities. ⁴¹All the cities of the Levites among the possessions of the children of Israel were forty-eight cities with their pasture lands. ⁴²Each of these cities included their pasture lands around them. It was this way with all these cities. ⁴³So the LORD gave to Israel all the land which he swore to give to their fathers. They possessed it, and lived in it. ⁴⁴The LORD gave them rest all around, according to all that he swore to their fathers. Not a man of all their enemies stood before them. The LORD delivered all their enemies into their hand. ⁴⁵Nothing failed of any good thing which the LORD had spoken to the house of Israel. All came to

pass.

22Then Joshua called the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, ²and said to them, “You have kept all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, and have listened to my voice in all that I commanded you. ³You have not left your brothers these many days to this day, but have performed the duty of the commandment of the LORD your God. ⁴Now the LORD your God has given rest to your brothers, as he spoke to them. Therefore now return and go to your tents, to the land of your possession, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave you beyond the Jordan. ⁵Only take diligent heed to do the commandment and the law which Moses the servant of the LORD commanded you, to love the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, to keep his commandments, to hold fast to him, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul.” ⁶So Joshua blessed them, and sent them away; and they went to their tents. ⁷Now to the one half-tribe of Manasseh Moses had given inheritance in Bashan; but Joshua gave to the other half among their brothers beyond the Jordan westward. Moreover when Joshua sent them away to their tents, he blessed them, ⁸and spoke to them, saying, “Return with much wealth to your tents, with very much livestock, with silver, with gold, with bronze, with iron, and with very much clothing. Divide the plunder of your enemies with your brothers.” ⁹The children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh returned, and departed from the children of Israel out of Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go to the land of Gilead, to the land of their possession, which they owned, according to the commandment of the LORD by Moses. ¹⁰When they came to the region near the Jordan, that is in the land of Canaan, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh built an altar there by the Jordan, a great altar to look at. ¹¹The children of Israel heard this, “Behold, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh have built an altar along the border of the land of Canaan, in the region around the Jordan, on the side that belongs to the children of Israel.” ¹²When the children of Israel heard of it, the whole congregation of the children of Israel gathered themselves together at Shiloh, to go up against them to war. ¹³The children of Israel sent to the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest. ¹⁴With him were ten princes, one prince of a fathers’ house for each of the tribes of Israel; and they were each head of their fathers’ houses among the thousands of Israel. ¹⁵They came to the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, to the land of Gilead, and they spoke with them, saying, ¹⁶“The whole congregation of the LORD says, ‘What trespass is this that you have commit-

ted against the God of Israel, to turn away today from following the LORD, in that you have built yourselves an altar, to rebel today against the LORD?’ ¹⁷Is the iniquity of Peor too little for us, from which we have not cleansed ourselves to this day, although there came a plague on the congregation of the LORD, ¹⁸that you must turn away today from following the LORD? It will be, since you rebel today against the LORD, that tomorrow he will be angry with the whole congregation of Israel. ¹⁹However, if the land of your possession is unclean, then pass over to the land of the possession of the LORD, in which the LORD’s tabernacle dwells, and take possession among us; but don’t rebel against the LORD, nor rebel against us, in building an altar other than the LORD our God’s altar. ²⁰Didn’t Achan the son of Zerah commit a trespass in the devoted thing, and wrath fell on all the congregation of Israel? That man didn’t perish alone in his iniquity.” ²¹Then the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh answered, and spoke to the heads of the thousands of Israel, ²²“The Mighty One, God, the LORD, the Mighty One, God, the LORD, he knows; and Israel shall know: if it was in rebellion, or if in trespass against the LORD (don’t save us today), ²³that we have built us an altar to turn away from following the LORD; or if to offer burnt offering or meal offering, or if to offer sacrifices of peace offerings, let the LORD himself require it. ²⁴‘If we have not out of concern done this, and for a reason, saying, ‘In time to come your children might speak to our children, saying, “What have you to do with the LORD, the God of Israel?’ ²⁵For the LORD has made the Jordan a border between us and you, you children of Reuben and children of Gad. You have no portion in the LORD.’” So your children might make our children cease from fearing the LORD. ²⁶“Therefore we said, ‘Let’s now prepare to build ourselves an altar, not for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice; ²⁷but it will be a witness between us and you, and between our generations after us, that we may perform the service of the LORD before him with our burnt offerings, with our sacrifices, and with our peace offerings;’ that your children may not tell our children in time to come, ‘You have no portion in the LORD.’” ²⁸“Therefore we said, ‘It shall be, when they tell us or our generations this in time to come, that we shall say, “Behold the pattern of the LORD’s altar, which our fathers made, not for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice; but it is a witness between us and you.”’” ²⁹“Far be it from us that we should rebel against the LORD, and turn away today from following the LORD, to build an altar for burnt offering, for meal offering, or for sacrifice, besides the LORD our God’s altar that is before his tabernacle!” ³⁰When Phinehas the priest, and the princes of the congregation, even the heads of the thousands of Israel that were with him, heard the words that the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the children of Manasseh spoke, it pleased them well.

³¹Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest said to the children of Reuben, to the children of Gad, and to the children of Manasseh, "Today we know that the LORD is among us, because you have not committed this trespass against the LORD. Now you have delivered the children of Israel out of the LORD's hand." ³²Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, and the princes, returned from the children of Reuben, and from the children of Gad, out of the land of Gilead, to the land of Canaan, to the children of Israel, and brought them word again. ³³The thing pleased the children of Israel; and the children of Israel blessed God, and spoke no more of going up against them to war, to destroy the land in which the children of Reuben and the children of Gad lived. ³⁴The children of Reuben and the children of Gad named the altar "A Witness Between Us that the LORD is God."

23After many days, when the LORD had given rest to Israel from their enemies all around, and Joshua was old and well advanced in years, ²Joshua called for all Israel, for their elders and for their heads, and for their judges and for their officers, and said to them, "I am old and well advanced in years. ³You have seen all that the LORD your God has done to all these nations because of you; for it is the LORD your God who has fought for you. ⁴Behold, I have allotted to you these nations that remain, to be an inheritance for your tribes, from the Jordan, with all the nations that I have cut off, even to the great sea toward the going down of the sun. ⁵The LORD your God will thrust them out from before you, and drive them from out of your sight. You shall possess their land, as the LORD your God spoke to you. ⁶"Therefore be very courageous to keep and to do all that is written in the scroll of the Torah of Moses, that you not turn away from it to the right hand or to the left; ⁷that you not come among these nations, these that remain among you; neither make mention of the name of their gods, nor cause to swear by them, neither serve them, nor bow down yourselves to them; ⁸but hold fast to the LORD your God, as you have done to this day. ⁹"For the LORD has driven great and strong nations out from before you. But as for you, no man has stood before you to this day. ¹⁰One man of you shall chase a thousand; for it is the LORD your God who fights for you, as he spoke to you. ¹¹Take good heed therefore to yourselves, that you love the LORD your God. ¹²"But if you do at all go back, and hold fast to the remnant of these nations, even these who remain among you, and make marriages with them, and go in to them, and they to you; ¹³know for a certainty that the LORD your God will no longer drive these nations from out of your sight; but they shall be a snare and a trap to you, a scourge in your sides, and thorns in your eyes, until you perish from off this good land which the LORD your God has given you. ¹⁴"Behold, today I am going the way of all the earth. You know in all your hearts and in

all your souls that not one thing has failed of all the good things which the LORD your God spoke concerning you. All have happened to you. Not one thing has failed of it. ¹⁵It shall happen that as all the good things have come on you of which the LORD your God spoke to you, so the LORD will bring on you all the evil things, until he has destroyed you from off this good land which the LORD your God has given you, ¹⁶when you disobey the covenant of the LORD your God, which he commanded you, and go and serve other gods, and bow down yourselves to them. Then the LORD's anger will be kindled against you, and you will perish quickly from off the good land which he has given to you."

24Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem, and called for the elders of Israel, for their heads, for their judges, and for their officers; and they presented themselves before God. ²Joshua said to all the people, "The LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'Your fathers lived of old time beyond the River, even Terah, the father of Abraham, and the father of Nahor. They served other gods. ³I took your father Abraham from beyond the River, and led him throughout all the land of Canaan, and multiplied his offspring,'^{xx} and gave him Isaac. ⁴I gave to Isaac Jacob and Esau: and I gave to Esau Mount Seir, to possess it. Jacob and his children went down into Egypt. ⁵"I sent Moses and Aaron, and I plagued Egypt, according to that which I did among them: and afterward I brought you out. ⁶I brought your fathers out of Egypt: and you came to the sea. The Egyptians pursued your fathers with chariots and with horsemen to the Sea of Suf. ⁷When they cried out to the LORD, he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea on them, and covered them; and your eyes saw what I did in Egypt. You lived in the wilderness many days. ⁸"I brought you into the land of the Amorites, that lived beyond the Jordan. They fought with you, and I gave them into your hand. You possessed their land, and I destroyed them from before you. ⁹Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and fought against Israel. He sent and called Balaam the son of Beor to curse you, ¹⁰but I would not listen to Balaam; therefore he blessed you still. So I delivered you out of his hand. ¹¹"You went over the Jordan, and came to Jericho. The men of Jericho fought against you, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Girgashite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite; and I delivered them into your hand. ¹²I sent the hornet before you, which drove them out from before you, even the two kings of the Amorites; not with your sword, nor with your bow. ¹³I gave you a land on which you had not labored, and cities which you didn't build, and you live in them. You eat of vineyards and olive groves which you didn't plant.' ¹⁴"Now therefore fear the LORD, and serve him in sincerity and in truth.

^{xx}or, seed

Put away the gods which your fathers served beyond the River, in Egypt; and serve the LORD. ¹⁵If it seems evil to you to serve the LORD, choose today whom you will serve; whether the gods which your fathers served that were beyond the River, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land you dwell; but as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.” ¹⁶The people answered, “Far be it from us that we should forsake the LORD, to serve other gods; ¹⁷for it is the LORD our God who brought us and our fathers up out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage, and who did those great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way in which we went, and among all the peoples through the middle of whom we passed. ¹⁸The LORD drove out from before us all the peoples, even the Amorites who lived in the land. Therefore we also will serve the LORD; for he is our God.” ¹⁹Joshua said to the people, “You can’t serve the LORD, for he is a holy God. He is a jealous God. He will not forgive your disobedience nor your sins. ²⁰If you forsake the LORD, and serve foreign gods, then he will turn and do you evil, and consume you, after he has done you good.” ²¹The people said to Joshua, “No, but we will serve the LORD.” ²²Joshua said to the people, “You are witnesses against yourselves that you have chosen the LORD yourselves, to serve him.” They said, “We are witnesses.” ²³“Now therefore put away the foreign gods which are among you, and incline your heart to the LORD, the God of Israel.” ²⁴The people said to Joshua, “We will serve the LORD our God, and we will listen to his voice.” ²⁵So Joshua made a covenant with the people that day, and made for them a statute and an ordinance in Shechem. ²⁶Joshua wrote these words in the scroll of the Torah of God; and he took a great stone, and set it up there under the oak that was by the sanctuary of the LORD. ²⁷Joshua said to all the people, “Behold, this stone shall be a witness against us, for it has heard all the LORD’s words which he spoke to us. It shall be therefore a witness against you, lest you deny your God.” ²⁸So Joshua sent the people away, each to his own inheritance. ²⁹After these things, Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being one hundred ten years old. ³⁰They buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnathserah, which is in the hill country of Ephraim, on the north of the mountain of Gaash. ³¹Israel served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders who outlived Joshua, and had known all the work of the LORD, that he had worked for Israel. ³²They buried the bones of Joseph, which the children of Israel brought up out of Egypt, in Shechem, in the parcel of ground which Jacob bought from the sons of Hamor the father of Shechem for a hundred pieces of silver. ^{xxi} They became the inheritance of the children of Joseph. ³³Eleazar the son of Aaron died. They buried him in the hill of Phinehas his son, which was given him in the hill country of Ephraim.

^{xxi}Hebrew: kesitahs. A kesitah was a kind of silver coin.

Judges

¹After the death of Joshua, the children of Israel asked of the LORD, ⁱ saying, “Who should go up for us first against the Canaanites, to fight against them?” ²The LORD said, “Judah shall go up. Behold, ⁱⁱ I have delivered the land into his hand.” ³Judah said to Simeon his brother, “Come up with me into my lot, that we may fight against the Canaanites; and I likewise will go with you into your lot.” So Simeon went with him. ⁴Judah went up, and the LORD delivered the Canaanites and the Perizzites into their hand. They struck ten thousand men in Bezek. ⁵They found Adoni-Bezek in Bezek, and they fought against him. They struck the Canaanites and the Perizzites. ⁶But Adoni-Bezek fled. They pursued him, caught him, and cut off his thumbs and his big toes. ⁷Adoni-Bezek said, “Seventy kings, having their thumbs and their big toes cut off, scavenged under my table. As I have done, so God ⁱⁱⁱ has done to me.” They brought him to Jerusalem, and he died there. ⁸The children of Judah fought against Jerusalem, took it, struck it with the edge of the sword, and set the city on fire. ⁹After that, the children of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanites who lived in the hill country, and in the South, and in the lowland. ¹⁰Judah went against the Canaanites who lived in Hebron. (The name of Hebron before that was Kiriath Arba.) They struck Sheshai, Ahiman, and Talmai. ¹¹From there he went against the inhabitants of Debir. (The name of Debir before that was Kiriath Sepher.) ¹²Caleb said, “I will give Achsah my daughter as wife to the man who strikes Kiriath Sepher, and takes it.” ¹³Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb’s younger brother, took it, so he gave him Achsah his daughter as his wife. ¹⁴When she came, she got him to ask her father for a field. She got off her donkey; and Caleb said to her, “What would you like?” ¹⁵She said to him, “Give me a blessing; because you have set me in the land of the South, give me also springs of water.” Then Caleb gave her the upper springs and the lower springs. ¹⁶The children of the Kenite, Moses’ brother-in-law, went up out of the city of palm trees with the children of Judah into the wilderness of Judah, which

is in the south of Arad; and they went and lived with the people. ¹⁷Judah went with Simeon his brother, and they struck the Canaanites who inhabited Zephath, and utterly destroyed it. The name of the city was called Hormah. ¹⁸Also Judah took Gaza with its border, and Ashkelon with its border, and Ekron with its border. ¹⁹The LORD was with Judah, and drove out the inhabitants of the hill country; for he could not drive out the inhabitants of the valley, because they had chariots of iron. ²⁰They gave Hebron to Caleb, as Moses had said, and he drove the three sons of Anak out of there. ²¹The children of Benjamin didn’t drive out the Jebusites who inhabited Jerusalem, but the Jebusites dwell with the children of Benjamin in Jerusalem to this day. ²²The house of Joseph also went up against Bethel, and the LORD was with them. ²³The house of Joseph sent to spy out Bethel. (The name of the city before that was Luz.) ²⁴The watchers saw a man come out of the city, and they said to him, “Please show us the entrance into the city, and we will deal kindly with you.” ²⁵He showed them the entrance into the city, and they struck the city with the edge of the sword; but they let the man and all his family go. ²⁶The man went into the land of the Hittites, built a city, and called its name Luz, which is its name to this day. ²⁷Manasseh didn’t drive out the inhabitants of Beth Shean and its towns, nor Taanach and its towns, nor the inhabitants of Dor and its towns, nor the inhabitants of Ibleam and its towns, nor the inhabitants of Megiddo and its towns; but the Canaanites would dwell in that land. ²⁸When Israel had grown strong, they put the Canaanites to forced labor, and didn’t utterly drive them out. ²⁹Ephraim didn’t drive out the Canaanites who lived in Gezer, but the Canaanites lived in Gezer among them. ³⁰Zebulun didn’t drive out the inhabitants of Kitron, nor the inhabitants of Nahalol; but the Canaanites lived among them, and became subject to forced labor. ³¹Asher didn’t drive out the inhabitants of Acco, nor the inhabitants of Sidon, nor of Ahlab, nor of Achzib, nor of Helbah, nor of Aphik, nor of Rehob; ³²but the Asherites lived among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land, for they didn’t drive them out. ³³Naphtali didn’t drive out the inhabitants of Beth Shemesh, nor the inhabitants of Beth Anath; but he lived among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land. Nevertheless the inhabitants of Beth

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱ“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is ” “ (Elohim).

Shemesh and of Beth Anath became subject to forced labor. ³⁴The Amorites forced the children of Dan into the hill country, for they would not allow them to come down to the valley; ³⁵but the Amorites would dwell in Mount Heres, in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim. Yet the hand of the house of Joseph prevailed, so that they became subject to forced labor. ³⁶The border of the Amorites was from the ascent of Akrabbim, from the rock, and upward.

2The LORD's angel came up from Gilgal to Bochim. He said, "I brought you out of Egypt, and have brought you to the land which I swore to give your fathers. I said, 'I will never break my covenant with you. ²You shall make no covenant with the inhabitants of this land. You shall break down their altars.' But you have not listened to my voice. Why have you done this? ³Therefore I also said, 'I will not drive them out from before you; but they shall be in your sides, and their gods will be a snare to you.'" ⁴When the LORD's angel spoke these words to all the children of Israel, the people lifted up their voice and wept. ⁵They called the name of that place Bochim, ^{iv} and they sacrificed there to the LORD. ⁶Now when Joshua had sent the people away, the children of Israel each went to his inheritance to possess the land. ⁷The people served the LORD all the days of Joshua, and all the days of the elders who outlived Joshua, who had seen all the great work of the LORD that he had worked for Israel. ⁸Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died, being one hundred ten years old. ⁹They buried him in the border of his inheritance in Timnath Heres, in the hill country of Ephraim, on the north of the mountain of Gaash. ¹⁰After all that generation were gathered to their fathers, another generation arose after them who didn't know the LORD, nor the work which he had done for Israel. ¹¹The children of Israel did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and served the Baals. ¹²They abandoned the LORD, the God of their fathers, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, and followed other gods, of the gods of the peoples who were around them, and bowed themselves down to them; and they provoked the LORD to anger. ¹³They abandoned the LORD, and served Baal and the Ashtaroth. ¹⁴The LORD's anger burned against Israel, and he delivered them into the hands of raiders who plundered them. He sold them into the hands of their enemies all around, so that they could no longer stand before their enemies. ¹⁵Wherever they went out, the LORD's hand was against them for evil, as the LORD had spoken, and as the LORD had sworn to them; and they were very distressed. ¹⁶The LORD raised up judges, who saved them out of the hand of those who plundered them. ¹⁷Yet they didn't listen to their judges; for they prostituted themselves to other gods, and bowed themselves down to them. They quickly turned away from the way in which their fathers walked,

obeying the LORD's commandments. They didn't do so. ¹⁸When the LORD raised up judges for them, then the LORD was with the judge, and saved them out of the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge; for it grieved the LORD because of their groaning by reason of those who oppressed them and troubled them. ¹⁹But when the judge was dead, they turned back, and dealt more corruptly than their fathers in following other gods to serve them and to bow down to them. They didn't cease what they were doing, or give up their stubborn ways. ²⁰The LORD's anger burned against Israel; and he said, "Because this nation transgressed my covenant which I commanded their fathers, and has not listened to my voice, ²¹I also will no longer drive out any of the nations that Joshua left when he died from before them; ²²that by them I may test Israel, to see if they will keep the LORD's way to walk therein, as their fathers kept it, or not." ²³So the LORD left those nations, without driving them out hastily. He didn't deliver them into Joshua's hand.

3Now these are the nations which the LORD left, to test Israel by them, even as many as had not known all the wars of Canaan; ²only that the generations of the children of Israel might know, to teach them war, at least those who knew nothing of it before: ³the five lords of the Philistines, all the Canaanites, the Sidonians, and the Hivites who lived on Mount Lebanon, from Mount Baal Hermon to the entrance of Hamath. ⁴They were left to test Israel by them, to know whether they would listen to the LORD's commandments, which he commanded their fathers by Moses. ⁵The children of Israel lived among the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites. ⁶They took their daughters to be their wives, and gave their own daughters to their sons and served their gods. ⁷The children of Israel did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and forgot the LORD their God, and served the Baals and the Asheroth. ⁸Therefore the LORD's anger burned against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of Cushan Rishathaim king of Mesopotamia; and the children of Israel served Cushan Rishathaim eight years. ⁹When the children of Israel cried to the LORD, the LORD raised up a savior to the children of Israel, who saved them, even Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother. ¹⁰The LORD's Spirit came on him, and he judged Israel; and he went out to war, and the LORD delivered Cushan Rishathaim king of Mesopotamia into his hand. His hand prevailed against Cushan Rishathaim. ¹¹The land had rest forty years, then Othniel the son of Kenaz died. ¹²The children of Israel again did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and the LORD strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel, because they had done that which was evil in the LORD's sight. ¹³He gathered the children of Ammon and Amalek to himself; and he went and struck Israel, and they

^{iv}"Bochim" means "weepers".

possessed the city of palm trees. ¹⁴The children of Israel served Eglon the king of Moab eighteen years. ¹⁵But when the children of Israel cried to the LORD, the LORD raised up a savior for them: Ehud the son of Gera, the Benjamite, a left-handed man. The children of Israel sent tribute by him to Eglon the king of Moab. ¹⁶Ehud made himself a sword which had two edges, a cubit ^v in length; and he wore it under his clothing on his right thigh. ¹⁷He offered the tribute to Eglon king of Moab. Now Eglon was a very fat man. ¹⁸When Ehud had finished offering the tribute, he sent away the people who carried the tribute. ¹⁹But he himself turned back from the stone idols that were by Gilgal, and said, "I have a secret message for you, O king." The king said, "Keep silence!" All who stood by him left him. ²⁰Ehud came to him; and he was sitting by himself alone in the cool upper room. Ehud said, "I have a message from God to you." He arose out of his seat. ²¹Ehud put out his left hand, and took the sword from his right thigh, and thrust it into his body. ²²The handle also went in after the blade; and the fat closed on the blade, for he didn't draw the sword out of his body; and it came out behind. ²³Then Ehud went out onto the porch, and shut the doors of the upper room on him, and locked them. ²⁴After he had gone, his servants came and saw that the doors of the upper room were locked. They said, "Surely he is covering his feet ^{vi} in the upper room." ²⁵They waited until they were ashamed; and behold, he didn't open the doors of the upper room. Therefore they took the key and opened them, and behold, their lord had fallen down dead on the floor. ²⁶Ehud escaped while they waited, passed beyond the stone idols, and escaped to Seirah. ²⁷When he had come, he blew a shofar in the hill country of Ephraim; and the children of Israel went down with him from the hill country, and he led them. ²⁸He said to them, "Follow me; for the LORD has delivered your enemies the Moabites into your hand." They followed him, and took the fords of the Jordan against the Moabites, and didn't allow any man to pass over. ²⁹They struck at that time about ten thousand men of Moab, every strong man and every man of valor. No man escaped. ³⁰So Moab was subdued that day under the hand of Israel. Then the land had rest eighty years. ³¹After him was Shamgar the son of Anath, who struck six hundred men of the Philistines with an ox goad. He also saved Israel.

⁴The children of Israel again did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, when Ehud was dead. ²The LORD sold them into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, who reigned in Hazor; the captain of whose army was Sisera, who lived in Harosheth of the Gentiles. ³The children of Israel cried to the LORD, for he had nine hundred chariots

of iron; and he mightily oppressed the children of Israel for twenty years. ⁴Now Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lappidoth, judged Israel at that time. ⁵She lived under Deborah's palm tree between Ramah and Bethel in the hill country of Ephraim; and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment. ⁶She sent and called Barak the son of Abinoam out of Kedesh Naphtali, and said to him, "Hasn't the LORD, the God of Israel, commanded, 'Go and lead the way to Mount Tabor, and take with you ten thousand men of the children of Naphtali and of the children of Zebulun?' ⁷I will draw to you, to the river Kishon, Sisera, the captain of Jabin's army, with his chariots and his multitude; and I will deliver him into your hand.'" ⁸Barak said to her, "If you will go with me, then I will go; but if you will not go with me, I will not go." ⁹She said, "I will surely go with you. Nevertheless, the journey that you take won't be for your honor; for the LORD will sell Sisera into a woman's hand." Deborah arose, and went with Barak to Kedesh. ¹⁰Barak called Zebulun and Naphtali together to Kedesh. Ten thousand men followed him; and Deborah went up with him. ¹¹Now Heber the Kenite had separated himself from the Kenites, even from the children of Hobab, Moses' brother-in-law, and had pitched his tent as far as the oak in Zaanannim, which is by Kedesh. ¹²They told Sisera that Barak the son of Abinoam had gone up to Mount Tabor. ¹³Sisera gathered together all his chariots, even nine hundred chariots of iron, and all the people who were with him, from Harosheth of the Gentiles, to the river Kishon. ¹⁴Deborah said to Barak, "Go; for this is the day in which the LORD has delivered Sisera into your hand. Hasn't the LORD gone out before you?" So Barak went down from Mount Tabor, and ten thousand men after him. ¹⁵The LORD confused Sisera, all his chariots, and all his army, with the edge of the sword before Barak. Sisera abandoned his chariot and fled away on his feet. ¹⁶But Barak pursued the chariots and the army to Harosheth of the Gentiles; and all the army of Sisera fell by the edge of the sword. There was not a man left. ¹⁷However Sisera fled away on his feet to the tent of Jael the wife of Heber the Kenite; for there was peace between Jabin the king of Hazor and the house of Heber the Kenite. ¹⁸Jael went out to meet Sisera, and said to him, "Turn in, my lord, turn in to me; don't be afraid." He came in to her into the tent, and she covered him with a rug. ¹⁹He said to her, "Please give me a little water to drink; for I am thirsty." She opened a container of milk, and gave him a drink, and covered him. ²⁰He said to her, "Stand in the door of the tent, and if any man comes and inquires of you, and says, 'Is there any man here?' you shall say, 'No.'" ²¹Then Jael, Heber's wife, took a tent peg, and took a hammer in her hand, and went softly to him, and struck the pin into his temples, and it pierced through into the ground, for he was in a deep sleep; so he fainted and died. ²²Behold, as Barak pursued Sisera, Jael came out to meet him, and said

^vA cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{vi}or, "relieving himself".

to him, "Come, and I will show you the man whom you seek." He came to her; and behold, Sisera lay dead, and the tent peg was in his temples. ²³So God subdued Jabin the king of Canaan before the children of Israel on that day. ²⁴The hand of the children of Israel prevailed more and more against Jabin the king of Canaan, until they had destroyed Jabin king of Canaan.

⁵Then Deborah and Barak the son of Abinoam sang on that day, saying, ²"Because the leaders took the lead in Israel, because the people offered themselves willingly, be blessed, LORD! ³"Hear, you kings! Give ear, you princes! I, even I, will sing to the LORD. I will sing praise to the LORD, the God of Israel. ⁴"LORD, when you went out of Seir, when you marched out of the field of Edom, the earth trembled, the sky also dropped. Yes, the clouds dropped water. ⁵The mountains quaked at the LORD's presence, even Sinai at the presence of the LORD, the God of Israel. ⁶"In the days of Shamgar the son of Anath, in the days of Jael, the highways were unoccupied. The travelers walked through byways. ⁷The rulers ceased in Israel. They ceased until I, Deborah, arose; Until I arose a mother in Israel. ⁸They chose new gods. Then war was in the gates. Was there a shield or spear seen among forty thousand in Israel? ⁹My heart is toward the governors of Israel, who offered themselves willingly among the people. Bless the LORD! ¹⁰"Speak, you who ride on white donkeys, you who sit on rich carpets, and you who walk by the way. ¹¹Far from the noise of archers, in the places of drawing water, there they will rehearse the LORD's righteous acts, the righteous acts of his rule in Israel. "Then the LORD's people went down to the gates. ¹²"Awake, awake, Deborah! Awake, awake, utter a song! Arise, Barak, and lead away your captives, you son of Abinoam.' ¹³"Then a remnant of the nobles and the people came down. The LORD came down for me against the mighty. ¹⁴Those whose root is in Amalek came out of Ephraim, after you, Benjamin, among your peoples. Governors come down out of Machir. Those who handle the marshal's staff came out of Zebulun. ¹⁵The princes of Issachar were with Deborah. As was Issachar, so was Barak. They rushed into the valley at his feet. By the watercourses of Reuben, there were great resolves of heart. ¹⁶Why did you sit among the sheepfolds? To hear the whistling for the flocks? At the watercourses of Reuben, there were great searchings of heart. ¹⁷Gilead lived beyond the Jordan. Why did Dan remain in ships? Asher sat still at the haven of the sea, and lived by his creeks. ¹⁸Zebulun was a people that jeopardized their lives to the death; Naphtali also, on the high places of the field. ¹⁹"The kings came and fought, then the kings of Canaan fought at Taanach by the waters of Megiddo. They took no plunder of silver. ²⁰From the sky the stars fought. From their courses, they fought against Sisera. ²¹The river Kishon swept them away, that ancient

river, the river Kishon. My soul, march on with strength. ²²Then the horse hoofs stamped because of the prancing, the prancing of their strong ones. ²³'Curse Meroz,' said the LORD's angel. 'Curse bitterly its inhabitants, because they didn't come to help the LORD, to help the LORD against the mighty.' ²⁴"Jael shall be blessed above women, the wife of Heber the Kenite; blessed shall she be above women in the tent. ²⁵He asked for water. She gave him milk. She brought him butter in a lordly dish. ²⁶She put her hand to the tent peg, and her right hand to the workmen's hammer. With the hammer she struck Sisera. She struck through his head. Yes, she pierced and struck through his temples. ²⁷At her feet he bowed, he fell, he lay. At her feet he bowed, he fell. Where he bowed, there he fell down dead. ²⁸"Through the window she looked out, and cried: Sisera's mother looked through the lattice. 'Why is his chariot so long in coming? Why do the wheels of his chariots wait?' ²⁹Her wise ladies answered her, Yes, she returned answer to herself, ³⁰'Have they not found, have they not divided the plunder? A lady, two ladies to every man; to Sisera a plunder of dyed garments, a plunder of dyed garments embroidered, of dyed garments embroidered on both sides, on the necks of the plunder?' ³¹"So let all your enemies perish, LORD, but let those who love him be as the sun when it rises in its strength." Then the land had rest forty years.

⁶The children of Israel did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, so the LORD delivered them into the hand of Midian seven years. ²The hand of Midian prevailed against Israel; and because of Midian the children of Israel made themselves the dens which are in the mountains, the caves, and the strongholds. ³So it was, when Israel had sown, that the Midianites, the Amalekites, and the children of the east came up against them. ⁴They encamped against them, and destroyed the increase of the earth, until you come to Gaza. They left no sustenance in Israel, and no sheep, ox, or donkey. ⁵For they came up with their livestock and their tents. They came in as locusts for multitude. Both they and their camels were without number; and they came into the land to destroy it. ⁶Israel was brought very low because of Midian; and the children of Israel cried to the LORD. ⁷When the children of Israel cried to the LORD because of Midian, ⁸The LORD sent a prophet to the children of Israel; and he said to them, "The LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'I brought you up from Egypt, and brought you out of the house of bondage. ⁹I delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians and out of the hand of all who oppressed you, and drove them out from before you, and gave you their land. ¹⁰I said to you, "I am the LORD your God. You shall not fear the gods of the Amorites, in whose land you dwell." But you have not listened to my voice.'" ¹¹The LORD's angel came and sat under the oak which was in Ophrah, that belonged to

Joash the Abiezrite. His son Gideon was beating out wheat in the wine press, to hide it from the Midianites. ¹²The LORD's angel appeared to him, and said to him, "The LORD is with you, you mighty man of valor!" ¹³Gideon said to him, "Oh, my lord, if the LORD is with us, why then has all this happened to us? Where are all his wondrous works which our fathers told us of, saying, 'Didn't the LORD bring us up from Egypt?' But now the LORD has cast us off, and delivered us into the hand of Midian." ¹⁴The LORD looked at him, and said, "Go in this your might, and save Israel from the hand of Midian. Haven't I sent you?" ¹⁵He said to him, "O Lord, ^{vii} how shall I save Israel? Behold, my family is the poorest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house." ¹⁶The LORD said to him, "Surely I will be with you, and you shall strike the Midianites as one man." ¹⁷He said to him, "If now I have found favor in your sight, then show me a sign that it is you who talk with me." ¹⁸Please don't go away until I come to you, and bring out my present, and lay it before you." He said, "I will wait until you come back." ¹⁹Gideon went in and prepared a young goat and unleavened cakes of an efah ^{viii} of meal. He put the meat in a basket and he put the broth in a pot, and brought it out to him under the oak, and presented it. ²⁰The angel of God said to him, "Take the meat and the unleavened cakes, and lay them on this rock, and pour out the broth." He did so. ²¹Then the LORD's angel stretched out the end of the staff that was in his hand, and touched the meat and the unleavened cakes; and fire went up out of the rock and consumed the meat and the unleavened cakes. Then the LORD's angel departed out of his sight. ²²Gideon saw that he was the LORD's angel; and Gideon said, "Alas, Lord GOD! Because I have seen the LORD's angel face to face!" ²³The LORD said to him, "Peace be to you! Don't be afraid. You shall not die." ²⁴Then Gideon built an altar there to the LORD, and called it "The LORD is Peace." ^{ix} To this day it is still in Ophrah of the Abiezrites. ²⁵That same night, the LORD said to him, "Take your father's bull, even the second bull seven years old, and throw down the altar of Baal that your father has, and cut down the Asherah that is by it. ²⁶Then build an altar to the LORD your God on the top of this stronghold, in an orderly way, and take the second bull, and offer a burnt offering with the wood of the Asherah which you shall cut down." ²⁷Then Gideon took ten men of his servants, and did as the LORD had spoken to him. Because he feared his father's household and the men of the city, he could not do it by day, but he did it by night. ²⁸When the men of the city arose early in the morning, behold, the altar of Baal was broken down, and the Asherah was cut down that was by it, and the second bull was offered on the altar that was built. ²⁹They said

to one another, "Who has done this thing?" When they inquired and asked, they said, "Gideon the son of Joash has done this thing." ³⁰Then the men of the city said to Joash, "Bring out your son, that he may die, because he has broken down the altar of Baal, and because he has cut down the Asherah that was by it." ³¹Joash said to all who stood against him, "Will you contend for Baal? Or will you save him? He who will contend for him, let him be put to death by morning! If he is a god, let him contend for himself, because someone has broken down his altar!" ³²Therefore on that day he named him Jerub-Baal, ^x saying, "Let Baal contend against him, because he has broken down his altar." ³³Then all the Midianites and the Amalekites and the children of the east assembled themselves together; and they passed over, and encamped in the valley of Jezreel. ³⁴But the LORD's Spirit came on Gideon, and he blew a shofar; and Abiezer was gathered together to follow him. ³⁵He sent messengers throughout all Manasseh, and they also were gathered together to follow him. He sent messengers to Asher, to Zebulun, and to Naphtali; and they came up to meet them. ³⁶Gideon said to God, "If you will save Israel by my hand, as you have spoken, ³⁷behold, I will put a fleece of wool on the threshing floor. If there is dew on the fleece only, and it is dry on all the ground, then I'll know that you will save Israel by my hand, as you have spoken." ³⁸It was so; for he rose up early on the next day, and pressed the fleece together, and wrung the dew out of the fleece, a bowl full of water. ³⁹Gideon said to God, "Don't let your anger be kindled against me, and I will speak but this once. Please let me make a trial just this once with the fleece. Let it now be dry only on the fleece, and on all the ground let there be dew." ⁴⁰God did so that night; for it was dry on the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

⁷Then Jerubbaal, who is Gideon, and all the people who were with him, rose up early and encamped beside the spring of Harod. Midian's camp was on the north side of them, by the hill of Moreh, in the valley. ²The LORD said to Gideon, "The people who are with you are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hand, lest Israel brag against me, saying, 'My own hand has saved me.' ³Now therefore proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, 'Whoever is fearful and trembling, let him return and depart from Mount Gilead.'" So twenty-two thousand of the people returned, and ten thousand remained. ⁴The LORD said to Gideon, "There are still too many people. Bring them down to the water, and I will test them for you there. It shall be, that those whom I tell you, 'This shall go with you,' shall go with you; and whoever I tell you, 'This shall not go with you,' shall not go." ⁵So he brought down the people to the water; and the LORD said to Gideon, "Everyone who laps of the water with his tongue, like a

^{vii}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{viii}1 efah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{ix}or, Shalom

^x"Jerub-Baal" means "Let Baal contend".

dog laps, you shall set him by himself; likewise everyone who bows down on his knees to drink.” ⁶The number of those who lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, was three hundred men; but all the rest of the people bowed down on their knees to drink water. ⁷The LORD said to Gideon, “I will save you by the three hundred men who lapped, and deliver the Midianites into your hand. Let all the other people go, each to his own place.” ⁸So the people took food in their hand, and their shofars ^{xi}; or, trumpet-sand he sent all the rest of the men of Israel to their own tents, but retained the three hundred men; and the camp of Midian was beneath him in the valley. ⁹That same night, the LORD said to him, “Arise, go down into the camp, for I have delivered it into your hand. ¹⁰But if you are afraid to go down, go with Purah your servant down to the camp. ¹¹You will hear what they say; and afterward your hands will be strengthened to go down into the camp.” Then went he down with Purah his servant to the outermost part of the armed men who were in the camp. ¹²The Midianites and the Amalekites and all the children of the east lay along in the valley like locusts for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand which is on the seashore for multitude. ¹³When Gideon had come, behold, there was a man telling a dream to his fellow. He said, “Behold, I dreamed a dream; and behold, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the camp of Midian, came to the tent, and struck it so that it fell, and turned it upside down, so that the tent lay flat.” ¹⁴His fellow answered, “This is nothing other than the sword of Gideon the son of Joash, a man of Israel. God has delivered Midian into his hand, with all the army.” ¹⁵It was so, when Gideon heard the telling of the dream and its interpretation, that he worshiped. Then he returned into the camp of Israel and said, “Arise, for the LORD has delivered the army of Midian into your hand!” ¹⁶He divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put into the hands of all of them shofars ^{xii} or, trumpetsand empty pitchers, with torches within the pitchers. ¹⁷He said to them, “Watch me, and do likewise. Behold, when I come to the outermost part of the camp, it shall be that, as I do, so you shall do. ¹⁸When I blow the shofar, I and all who are with me, then blow the shofars ^{xiii} or, trumpet-salso on every side of all the camp, and shout, ‘For the LORD and for Gideon!’” ¹⁹So Gideon and the hundred men who were with him came to the outermost part of the camp in the beginning of the middle watch, when they had but newly set the watch. Then they blew the shofars ^{xiv} or, trumpetsand broke in pieces the pitchers that were in their hands. ²⁰The three companies blew the shofars

^{xv}, or, trumpetsbroke the pitchers, and held the torches in their left hands and the shofars ^{xvi} or, trumpetsin their right hands with which to blow; and they shouted, “The sword of the LORD and of Gideon!” ²¹They each stood in his place around the camp, and all the army ran; and they shouted, and put them to flight. ²²They blew the three hundred shofars ^{xvii}, or, trumpetsand the LORD set every man’s sword against his fellow and against all the army; and the army fled as far as Beth Shittah toward Zererah, as far as the border of Abel Meholah, by Tab-bath. ²³The men of Israel were gathered together out of Naphtali, out of Asher, and out of all Manasseh, and pursued Midian. ²⁴Gideon sent messengers throughout all the hill country of Ephraim, saying, “Come down against Midian and take the waters before them as far as Beth Barah, even the Jordan!” So all the men of Ephraim were gathered together and took the waters as far as Beth Barah, even the Jordan. ²⁵They took the two princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb. They killed Oreb at Oreb’s rock, and Zeeb they killed at Zeeb’s wine press, as they pursued Midian. Then they brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon beyond the Jordan.

⁸The men of Ephraim said to him, “Why have you treated us this way, that you didn’t call us when you went to fight with Midian?” They rebuked him sharply. ²He said to them, “What have I now done in comparison with you? Isn’t the gleanings of the grapes of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer? ³God has delivered into your hand the princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb! What was I able to do in comparison with you?” Then their anger was abated toward him when he had said that. ⁴Gideon came to the Jordan and passed over, he and the three hundred men who were with him, faint, yet pursuing. ⁵He said to the men of Succoth, “Please give loaves of bread to the people who follow me; for they are faint, and I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, the kings of Midian.” ⁶The princes of Succoth said, “Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in your hand, that we should give bread to your army?” ⁷Gideon said, “Therefore when the LORD has delivered Zebah and Zalmunna into my hand, then I will tear your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with briers.” ⁸He went up there to Penuel, and spoke to them in the same way; and the men of Penuel answered him as the men of Succoth had answered. ⁹He spoke also to the men of Penuel, saying, “When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower.” ¹⁰Now Zebah and Zalmunna were in Karkor, and their armies with them, about fifteen thousand men, all who were left of all the army of the children of the east; for there fell one hundred twenty thousand men who drew sword. ¹¹Gideon went up by the way of those

^{xi}or, trumpets;

^{xii}or, trumpets

^{xiii}or, trumpets

^{xiv}or, trumpets

^{xv}or, trumpets,

^{xvi}or, trumpets

^{xvii}or, trumpets,

who lived in tents on the east of Nobah and Jogbehah, and struck the army; for the army felt secure. ¹²Zebah and Zalmunna fled and he pursued them. He took the two kings of Midian, Zebah and Zalmunna, and confused all the army. ¹³Gideon the son of Joash returned from the battle from the ascent of Heres. ¹⁴He caught a young man of the men of Succoth, and inquired of him; and he described for him the princes of Succoth, and its elders, seventy-seven men. ¹⁵He came to the men of Succoth, and said, "See Zebah and Zalmunna, concerning whom you taunted me, saying, 'Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in your hand, that we should give bread to your men who are weary?'" ¹⁶He took the elders of the city, and thorns of the wilderness and briers, and with them he taught the men of Succoth. ¹⁷He broke down the tower of Penuel, and killed the men of the city. ¹⁸Then he said to Zebah and Zalmunna, "What kind of men were they whom you killed at Tabor?" They answered, "They were like you. They all resembled the children of a king." ¹⁹He said, "They were my brothers, the sons of my mother. As the LORD lives, if you had saved them alive, I would not kill you." ²⁰He said to Jether his firstborn, "Get up and kill them!" But the youth didn't draw his sword; for he was afraid, because he was yet a youth. ²¹Then Zebah and Zalmunna said, "You rise and fall on us; for as the man is, so is his strength." Gideon arose, and killed Zebah and Zalmunna, and took the crescents that were on their camels' necks. ²²Then the men of Israel said to Gideon, "Rule over us, both you, your son, and your son's son also; for you have saved us out of the hand of Midian." ²³Gideon said to them, "I will not rule over you, neither shall my son rule over you. The LORD shall rule over you." ²⁴Gideon said to them, "I do have a request: that you would each give me the earrings of his plunder." (For they had golden earrings, because they were Ishmaelites.) ²⁵They answered, "We will willingly give them." They spread a garment, and every man threw the earrings of his plunder into it. ²⁶The weight of the golden earrings that he requested was one thousand and seven hundred shekels ^{xviii} of gold, in addition to the crescents, and the pendants, and the purple clothing that was on the kings of Midian, and in addition to the chains that were about their camels' necks. ²⁷Gideon made an ephod out of it, and put it in Ophrah, his city. Then all Israel played the prostitute with it there; and it became a snare to Gideon and to his house. ²⁸So Midian was subdued before the children of Israel, and they lifted up their heads no more. The land had rest forty years in the days of Gideon. ²⁹Jerubbaal the son of Joash went and lived in his own house. ³⁰Gideon had seventy sons conceived from his body, for he had many wives. ³¹His concubine who was in Shechem also bore him a son, and he named him Abimelech. ³²Gideon the son of Joash died in a good

old age, and was buried in the tomb of Joash his father, in Ophrah of the Abiezrites. ³³As soon as Gideon was dead, the children of Israel turned again and played the prostitute following the Baals, and made Baal Berith their god. ³⁴The children of Israel didn't remember the LORD their God, who had delivered them out of the hand of all their enemies on every side; ³⁵neither did they show kindness to the house of Jerubbaal, that is, Gideon, according to all the goodness which he had shown to Israel.

⁹Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal went to Shechem to his mother's brothers, and spoke with them and with all the family of the house of his mother's father, saying, ²"Please speak in the ears of all the men of Shechem, 'Is it better for you that all the sons of Jerubbaal, who are seventy persons, rule over you, or that one rule over you?' Remember also that I am your bone and your flesh." ³His mother's brothers spoke of him in the ears of all the men of Shechem all these words. Their hearts inclined to follow Abimelech; for they said, "He is our brother." ⁴They gave him seventy pieces of silver out of the house of Baal Berith, with which Abimelech hired vain and reckless fellows who followed him. ⁵He went to his father's house at Ophrah, and killed his brothers the sons of Jerubbaal, being seventy persons, on one stone; but Jotham the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left, for he hid himself. ⁶All the men of Shechem assembled themselves together with all the house of Millo, and went and made Abimelech king by the oak of the pillar that was in Shechem. ⁷When they told it to Jotham, he went and stood on the top of Mount Gerizim and lifted up his voice, cried out, and said to them, "Listen to me, you men of Shechem, that God may listen to you. ⁸The trees set out to anoint a king over themselves. They said to the olive tree, 'Reign over us.' ⁹"But the olive tree said to them, 'Should I stop producing my oil, with which they honor God and man by me, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?' ¹⁰"The trees said to the fig tree, 'Come and reign over us.' ¹¹"But the fig tree said to them, 'Should I leave my sweetness, and my good fruit, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?' ¹²"The trees said to the vine, 'Come and reign over us.' ¹³"The vine said to them, 'Should I leave my new wine, which cheers God and man, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?' ¹⁴"Then all the trees said to the bramble, 'Come and reign over us.' ¹⁵"The bramble said to the trees, 'If in truth you anoint me king over you, then come and take refuge in my shade; and if not, let fire come out of the bramble, and devour the cedars of Lebanon.' ¹⁶"Now therefore, if you have dealt truly and righteously, in that you have made Abimelech king, and if you have dealt well with Jerubbaal and his house, and have done to him according to the deserving of his hands ¹⁷(for my father fought for you, risked his life, and delivered you out of the hand of Midian; ¹⁸and you have risen up against

^{xviii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 1700 shekels is about 17 kilograms or 37.4 pounds.

my father's house today and have slain his sons, seventy persons, on one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his female servant, king over the men of Shechem, because he is your brother); ¹⁹if you then have dealt truly and righteously with Jerubbaal and with his house today, then rejoice in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you; ²⁰but if not, let fire come out from Abimelech and devour the men of Shechem and the house of Millo; and let fire come out from the men of Shechem and from the house of Millo and devour Abimelech." ²¹Jotham ran away and fled, and went to Beer^{xix} and lived there, for fear of Abimelech his brother. ²²Abimelech was prince over Israel three years. ²³Then God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Shechem; and the men of Shechem dealt treacherously with Abimelech, ²⁴that the violence done to the seventy sons of Jerubbaal might come, and that their blood might be laid on Abimelech their brother who killed them, and on the men of Shechem who strengthened his hands to kill his brothers. ²⁵The men of Shechem set an ambush for him on the tops of the mountains, and they robbed all who came along that way by them; and Abimelech was told about it. ²⁶Gaal the son of Ebed came with his brothers and went over to Shechem; and the men of Shechem put their trust in him. ²⁷They went out into the field, harvested their vineyards, trod the grapes, celebrated, and went into the house of their god and ate and drank, and cursed Abimelech. ²⁸Gaal the son of Ebed said, "Who is Abimelech, and who is Shechem, that we should serve him? Isn't he the son of Jerubbaal? Isn't Zebul his officer? Serve the men of Hamor the father of Shechem, but why should we serve him? ²⁹I wish that this people were under my hand! Then I would remove Abimelech." He said to Abimelech, "Increase your army and come out!" ³⁰When Zebul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal the son of Ebed, his anger burned. ³¹He sent messengers to Abimelech craftily, saying, "Behold, Gaal the son of Ebed and his brothers have come to Shechem; and behold, they incite the city against you. ³²Now therefore, go up by night, you and the people who are with you, and lie in wait in the field. ³³It shall be that in the morning, as soon as the sun is up, you shall rise early and rush on the city. Behold, when he and the people who are with him come out against you, then may you do to them as you shall find occasion." ³⁴Abimelech rose up, and all the people who were with him, by night, and they laid wait against Shechem in four companies. ³⁵Gaal the son of Ebed went out, and stood in the entrance of the gate of the city. Abimelech rose up, and the people who were with him, from the ambush. ³⁶When Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul, "Behold, people are coming down from the tops of the mountains." Zebul said to him, "You see the shadows of the mountains as if they were men." ³⁷Gaal spoke again and said, "Behold, people are coming down by

the middle of the land, and one company comes by the way of the oak of Meonenim." ³⁸Then Zebul said to him, "Now where is your mouth, that you said, 'Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him?' Isn't this the people that you have despised? Please go out now and fight with them." ³⁹Gaal went out before the men of Shechem, and fought with Abimelech. ⁴⁰Abimelech chased him, and he fled before him, and many fell wounded, even to the entrance of the gate. ⁴¹Abimelech lived at Arumah; and Zebul drove out Gaal and his brothers, that they should not dwell in Shechem. ⁴²On the next day, the people went out into the field; and they told Abimelech. ⁴³He took the people and divided them into three companies, and laid wait in the field; and he looked, and behold, the people came out of the city. So, he rose up against them and struck them. ⁴⁴Abimelech and the companies that were with him rushed forward and stood in the entrance of the gate of the city; and the two companies rushed on all who were in the field and struck them. ⁴⁵Abimelech fought against the city all that day; and he took the city and killed the people in it. He beat down the city and sowed it with salt. ⁴⁶When all the men of the tower of Shechem heard of it, they entered into the stronghold of the house of Elberith. ⁴⁷Abimelech was told that all the men of the tower of Shechem were gathered together. ⁴⁸Abimelech went up to Mount Zalmon, he and all the people who were with him; and Abimelech took an ax in his hand, and cut down a bough from the trees, and took it up, and laid it on his shoulder. Then he said to the people who were with him, "What you have seen me do, make haste, and do as I have done!" ⁴⁹All the people likewise each cut down his bough, followed Abimelech, and put them at the base of the stronghold, and set the stronghold on fire over them, so that all the people of the tower of Shechem died also, about a thousand men and women. ⁵⁰Then Abimelech went to Thebez and encamped against Thebez, and took it. ⁵¹But there was a strong tower within the city, and all the men and women of the city fled there, and shut themselves in, and went up to the roof of the tower. ⁵²Abimelech came to the tower and fought against it, and came near to the door of the tower to burn it with fire. ⁵³A certain woman cast an upper millstone on Abimelech's head, and broke his skull. ⁵⁴Then he called hastily to the young man, his armor bearer, and said to him, "Draw your sword and kill me, that men not say of me, 'A woman killed him.' His young man thrust him through, and he died." ⁵⁵When the men of Israel saw that Abimelech was dead, they each departed to his place. ⁵⁶Thus God repaid the wickedness of Abimelech, which he did to his father in killing his seventy brothers; ⁵⁷and God repaid all the wickedness of the men of Shechem on their heads; and the curse of Jotham the son of Jerubbaal came on them.

^{xix}"Beer" is Hebrew for "well", i.e., a village named for its well.

10After Abimelech, Tola the son of Puah, the son of

Dodo, a man of Issachar, arose to save Israel. He lived in Shamir in the hill country of Ephraim. ²He judged Israel twenty-three years, and died, and was buried in Shamir. ³After him Jair, the Gileadite, arose. He judged Israel twenty-two years. ⁴He had thirty sons who rode on thirty donkey colts. They had thirty cities, which are called Havvoth Jair to this day, which are in the land of Gilead. ⁵Jair died, and was buried in Kamon. ⁶The children of Israel again did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and served the Baals, the Ashtaroth, the gods of Syria, the gods of Sidon, the gods of Moab, the gods of the children of Ammon, and the gods of the Philistines. They abandoned the LORD, and didn't serve him. ⁷The LORD's anger burned against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of the Philistines and into the hand of the children of Ammon. ⁸They troubled and oppressed the children of Israel that year. For eighteen years they oppressed all the children of Israel that were beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorites, which is in Gilead. ⁹The children of Ammon passed over the Jordan to fight also against Judah, and against Benjamin, and against the house of Ephraim, so that Israel was very distressed. ¹⁰The children of Israel cried to the LORD, saying, "We have sinned against you, even because we have forsaken our God, and have served the Baals." ¹¹The LORD said to the children of Israel, "Didn't I save you from the Egyptians, and from the Amorites, from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines?" ¹²The Sidonians also, and the Amalekites, and the Maonites, oppressed you; and you cried to me, and I saved you out of their hand. ¹³Yet you have forsaken me and served other gods. Therefore I will save you no more. ¹⁴Go and cry to the gods which you have chosen. Let them save you in the time of your distress!" ¹⁵The children of Israel said to the LORD, "We have sinned! Do to us whatever seems good to you; only deliver us, please, today." ¹⁶They put away the foreign gods from among them and served the LORD; and his soul was grieved for the misery of Israel. ¹⁷Then the children of Ammon were gathered together and encamped in Gilead. The children of Israel assembled themselves together and encamped in Mizpah. ¹⁸The people, the princes of Gilead, said to one another, "Who is the man who will begin to fight against the children of Ammon? He shall be head over all the inhabitants of Gilead."

11 Now Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty man of valor. He was the son of a prostitute. Gilead became the father of Jephthah. ²Gilead's wife bore him sons. When his wife's sons grew up, they drove Jephthah out and said to him, "You will not inherit in our father's house, for you are the son of another woman." ³Then Jephthah fled from his brothers and lived in the land of Tob. Outlaws joined up with Jephthah, and they went out with him. ⁴After a while, the children of Ammon made war against

Israel. ⁵When the children of Ammon made war against Israel, the elders of Gilead went to get Jephthah out of the land of Tob. ⁶They said to Jephthah, "Come and be our chief, that we may fight with the children of Ammon." ⁷Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead, "Didn't you hate me, and drive me out of my father's house? Why have you come to me now when you are in distress?" ⁸The elders of Gilead said to Jephthah, "Therefore we have turned again to you now, that you may go with us and fight with the children of Ammon. You will be our head over all the inhabitants of Gilead." ⁹Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead, "If you bring me home again to fight with the children of Ammon, and the LORD delivers them before me, will I be your head?" ¹⁰The elders of Gilead said to Jephthah, "The LORD will be witness between us. Surely we will do what you say." ¹¹Then Jephthah went with the elders of Gilead, and the people made him head and chief over them. Jephthah spoke all his words before the LORD in Mizpah. ¹²Jephthah sent messengers to the king of the children of Ammon, saying, "What do you have to do with me, that you have come to me to fight against my land?" ¹³The king of the children of Ammon answered the messengers of Jephthah, "Because Israel took away my land when he came up out of Egypt, from the Arnon even to the Jabbok, and to the Jordan. Now therefore restore that territory again peaceably." ¹⁴Jephthah sent messengers again to the king of the children of Ammon; ¹⁵and he said to him, "Jephthah says: Israel didn't take away the land of Moab, nor the land of the children of Ammon; ¹⁶but when they came up from Egypt, and Israel went through the wilderness to the Sea of Suf, and came to Kadesh, ¹⁷then Israel sent messengers to the king of Edom, saying, 'Please let me pass through your land;' but the king of Edom didn't listen. In the same way, he sent to the king of Moab, but he refused; so Israel stayed in Kadesh. ¹⁸Then they went through the wilderness, and went around the land of Edom, and the land of Moab, and came by the east side of the land of Moab, and they encamped on the other side of the Arnon; but they didn't come within the border of Moab, for the Arnon was the border of Moab. ¹⁹Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, the king of Heshbon; and Israel said to him, 'Please let us pass through your land to my place.' ²⁰But Sihon didn't trust Israel to pass through his border; but Sihon gathered all his people together, and encamped in Jahaz, and fought against Israel. ²¹The LORD, the God of Israel, delivered Sihon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and they struck them. So Israel possessed all the land of the Amorites, the inhabitants of that country. ²²They possessed all the border of the Amorites, from the Arnon even to the Jabbok, and from the wilderness even to the Jordan. ²³So now the LORD, the God of Israel, has dispossessed the Amorites from before his people Israel, and should you possess them? ²⁴Won't you possess that

which Chemosh your god gives you to possess? So whoever the LORD our God has dispossessed from before us, them will we possess. ²⁵Now are you anything better than Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab? Did he ever strive against Israel, or did he ever fight against them? ²⁶Israel lived in Heshbon and its towns, and in Aroer and its towns, and in all the cities that are along the side of the Arnon for three hundred years! Why didn't you recover them within that time? ²⁷Therefore I have not sinned against you, but you do me wrong to war against me. May The LORD the Judge be judge today between the children of Israel and the children of Ammon." ²⁸However, the king of the children of Ammon didn't listen to the words of Jephthah which he sent him. ²⁹Then the LORD's Spirit came on Jephthah, and he passed over Gilead and Manasseh, and passed over Mizpah of Gilead, and from Mizpah of Gilead he passed over to the children of Ammon. ³⁰Jephthah vowed a vow to the LORD, and said, "If you will indeed deliver the children of Ammon into my hand, ³¹then it shall be, that whatever comes out of the doors of my house to meet me when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, it shall be the LORD's, and I will offer it up for a burnt offering." ³²So Jephthah passed over to the children of Ammon to fight against them; and the LORD delivered them into his hand. ³³He struck them from Aroer until you come to Minnith, even twenty cities, and to Abelcheramim, with a very great slaughter. So the children of Ammon were subdued before the children of Israel. ³⁴Jephthah came to Mizpah to his house; and behold, his daughter came out to meet him with tambourines and with dances. She was his only child. Besides her he had neither son nor daughter. ³⁵When he saw her, he tore his clothes, and said, "Alas, my daughter! You have brought me very low, and you are one of those who trouble me; for I have opened my mouth to the LORD, and I can't go back." ³⁶She said to him, "My father, you have opened your mouth to the LORD; do to me according to that which has proceeded out of your mouth, because the LORD has taken vengeance for you on your enemies, even on the children of Ammon." ³⁷Then she said to her father, "Let this thing be done for me. Leave me alone two months, that I may depart and go down on the mountains, and bewail my virginity, I and my companions." ³⁸He said, "Go." He sent her away for two months; and she departed, she and her companions, and mourned her virginity on the mountains. ³⁹At the end of two months, she returned to her father, who did with her according to his vow which he had vowed. She was a virgin. It became a custom in Israel ⁴⁰that the daughters of Israel went yearly to celebrate the daughter of Jephthah the Gileadite four days in a year.

¹²The men of Ephraim were gathered together, and passed northward; and they said to Jephthah, "Why did you pass over to fight against the children of Ammon, and

didn't call us to go with you? We will burn your house around you with fire!" ²Jephthah said to them, "I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon; and when I called you, you didn't save me out of their hand. ³When I saw that you didn't save me, I put my life in my hand, and passed over against the children of Ammon, and the LORD delivered them into my hand. Why then have you come up to me today, to fight against me?" ⁴Then Jephthah gathered together all the men of Gilead, and fought with Ephraim. The men of Gilead struck Ephraim, because they said, "You are fugitives of Ephraim, you Gileadites, in the middle of Ephraim, and in the middle of Manasseh." ⁵The Gileadites took the fords of the Jordan against the Ephraimites. Whenever a fugitive of Ephraim said, "Let me go over," the men of Gilead said to him, "Are you an Ephraimite?" If he said, "No;" ⁶then they said to him, "Now say 'Shibboleth;'" and he said "Sibboleth"; for he couldn't manage to pronounce it correctly, then they seized him and killed him at the fords of the Jordan. At that time, forty-two thousand of Ephraim fell. ⁷Jephthah judged Israel six years. Then Jephthah the Gileadite died, and was buried in the cities of Gilead. ⁸After him Ibzan of Bethlehem judged Israel. ⁹He had thirty sons. He sent his thirty daughters outside his clan, and he brought in thirty daughters from outside his clan for his sons. He judged Israel seven years. ¹⁰Ibzan died, and was buried at Bethlehem. ¹¹After him, Elon the Zebulunite judged Israel; and he judged Israel ten years. ¹²Elon the Zebulunite died, and was buried in Aijalon in the land of Zebulun. ¹³After him, Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite judged Israel. ¹⁴He had forty sons and thirty sons' sons who rode on seventy donkey colts. He judged Israel eight years. ¹⁵Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite died, and was buried in Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the hill country of the Amalekites.

¹³The children of Israel again did that which was evil in the LORD's sight; and the LORD delivered them into the hand of the Philistines forty years. ²There was a certain man of Zorah, of the family of the Danites, whose name was Manoah; and his wife was barren, and childless. ³The LORD's angel appeared to the woman, and said to her, "See now, you are barren and childless; but you shall conceive and bear a son. ⁴Now therefore please beware and drink no wine nor strong drink, and don't eat any unclean thing; ⁵for, behold, you shall conceive and give birth to a son. No razor shall come on his head, for the child shall be a Nazirite to God from the womb. He shall begin to save Israel out of the hand of the Philistines." ⁶Then the woman came and told her husband, saying, "A man of God came to me, and his face was like the face of the angel of God, very awesome. I didn't ask him where he was from, neither did he tell me his name; ⁷but he said to me, 'Behold, you shall conceive and bear a son; and now drink

no wine nor strong drink. Don't eat any unclean thing, for the child shall be a Nazirite to God from the womb to the day of his death." ⁸Then Manoah entreated the LORD, and said, "Oh, Lord, please let the man of God whom you sent come again to us, and teach us what we should do to the child who shall be born." ⁹God listened to the voice of Manoah, and the angel of God came again to the woman as she sat in the field; but Manoah, her husband, wasn't with her. ¹⁰The woman hurried and ran, and told her husband, saying to him, "Behold, the man who came to me that day has appeared to me." ¹¹Manoah arose and followed his wife, and came to the man, and said to him, "Are you the man who spoke to my wife?" He said, "I am." ¹²Manoah said, "Now let your words happen. What shall the child's way of life and mission be?" ¹³The LORD's angel said to Manoah, "Of all that I said to the woman let her beware. ¹⁴She may not eat of anything that comes of the vine, neither let her drink wine or strong drink, nor eat any unclean thing. Let her observe all that I commanded her." ¹⁵Manoah said to the LORD's angel, "Please stay with us, that we may make a young goat ready for you." ¹⁶The LORD's angel said to Manoah, "Though you detain me, I won't eat your bread. If you will prepare a burnt offering, you must offer it to the LORD." For Manoah didn't know that he was the LORD's angel. ¹⁷Manoah said to the LORD's angel, "What is your name, that when your words happen, we may honor you?" ¹⁸The LORD's angel said to him, "Why do you ask about my name, since it is incomprehensible ^{xx}?" ¹⁹So Manoah took the young goat with the meal offering, and offered it on the rock to the LORD. Then the angel did an amazing thing as Manoah and his wife watched. ²⁰For when the flame went up toward the sky from off the altar, the LORD's angel ascended in the flame of the altar. Manoah and his wife watched; and they fell on their faces to the ground. ²¹But the LORD's angel didn't appear to Manoah or to his wife any more. Then Manoah knew that he was the LORD's angel. ²²Manoah said to his wife, "We shall surely die, because we have seen God." ²³But his wife said to him, "If the LORD were pleased to kill us, he wouldn't have received a burnt offering and a meal offering at our hand, and he wouldn't have shown us all these things, nor would he have told us such things as these at this time." ²⁴The woman bore a son and named him Samson. The child grew, and the LORD blessed him. ²⁵The LORD's Spirit began to move him in Mahaneh Dan, between Zorah and Eshtaol.

¹⁴Samson went down to Timnah, and saw a woman in Timnah of the daughters of the Philistines. ²He came up, and told his father and his mother, saying, "I have seen a woman in Timnah of the daughters of the Philistines. Now therefore get her for me as my wife." ³Then his father and his mother said to him, "Isn't there a woman among your

brothers' daughters, or among all my people, that you go to take a wife of the uncircumcised Philistines?" Samson said to his father, "Get her for me, for she pleases me well." ⁴But his father and his mother didn't know that it was of the LORD; for he sought an occasion against the Philistines. Now at that time the Philistines ruled over Israel. ⁵Then Samson went down to Timnah with his father and his mother, and came to the vineyards of Timnah; and behold, a young lion roared at him. ⁶The LORD's Spirit came mightily on him, and he tore him as he would have torn a young goat with his bare hands, but he didn't tell his father or his mother what he had done. ⁷He went down and talked with the woman, and she pleased Samson well. ⁸After a while he returned to take her, and he went over to see the carcass of the lion; and behold, there was a swarm of bees in the body of the lion, and honey. ⁹He took it into his hands, and went on, eating as he went. He came to his father and mother and gave to them, and they ate, but he didn't tell them that he had taken the honey out of the lion's body. ¹⁰His father went down to the woman; and Samson made a feast there, for the young men used to do so. ¹¹When they saw him, they brought thirty companions to be with him. ¹²Samson said to them, "Let me tell you a riddle now. If you can tell me the answer within the seven days of the feast, and find it out, then I will give you thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothing; ¹³but if you can't tell me the answer, then you shall give me thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothing." They said to him, "Tell us your riddle, that we may hear it." ¹⁴He said to them, "Out of the eater came out food. Out of the strong came out sweetness." They couldn't in three days declare the riddle. ¹⁵On the seventh day, they said to Samson's wife, "Entice your husband, that he may declare to us the riddle, lest we burn you and your father's house with fire. Have you called us to impoverish us? Isn't that so?" ¹⁶Samson's wife wept before him, and said, "You just hate me, and don't love me. You've told a riddle to the children of my people, and haven't told it to me." He said to her, "Behold, I haven't told my father or my mother, so why should I tell you?" ¹⁷She wept before him the seven days, while their feast lasted; and on the seventh day, he told her, because she pressed him severely; and she told the riddle to the children of her people. ¹⁸The men of the city said to him on the seventh day before the sun went down, "What is sweeter than honey? What is stronger than a lion?" He said to them, "If you hadn't plowed with my heifer, you wouldn't have found out my riddle." ¹⁹The LORD's Spirit came mightily on him, and he went down to Ashkelon and struck thirty men of them. He took their plunder, then gave the changes of clothing to those who declared the riddle. His anger burned, and he went up to his father's house. ²⁰But Samson's wife was given to his companion, who had been his friend.

^{xx}or, wonderful

¹⁵But after a while, in the time of wheat harvest, Samson visited his wife with a young goat. He said, "I will go in to my wife's room." But her father wouldn't allow him to go in. ²Her father said, "I most certainly thought that you utterly hated her; therefore I gave her to your companion. Isn't her younger sister more beautiful than she? Please, take her instead." ³Samson said to them, "This time I will be blameless in the case of the Philistines when I harm them." ⁴Samson went and caught three hundred foxes, and took torches, and turned tail to tail, and put a torch in the middle between every two tails. ⁵When he had set the torches on fire, he let them go into the standing grain of the Philistines, and burned up both the shocks and the standing grain, and also the olive groves. ⁶Then the Philistines said, "Who has done this?" They said, "Samson, the son-in-law of the Timnite, because he has taken his wife and given her to his companion." The Philistines came up, and burned her and her father with fire. ⁷Samson said to them, "If you behave like this, surely I will take revenge on you, and after that I will cease." ⁸He struck them hip and thigh with a great slaughter; and he went down and lived in the cave in Etam's rock. ⁹Then the Philistines went up, encamped in Judah, and spread themselves in Lehi. ¹⁰The men of Judah said, "Why have you come up against us?" They said, "We have come up to bind Samson, to do to him as he has done to us." ¹¹Then three thousand men of Judah went down to the cave in Etam's rock, and said to Samson, "Don't you know that the Philistines are rulers over us? What then is this that you have done to us?" He said to them, "As they did to me, so I have done to them." ¹²They said to him, "We have come down to bind you, that we may deliver you into the hand of the Philistines." Samson said to them, "Swear to me that you will not attack me yourselves." ¹³They spoke to him, saying, "No, but we will bind you securely and deliver you into their hands; but surely we will not kill you." They bound him with two new ropes, and brought him up from the rock. ¹⁴When he came to Lehi, the Philistines shouted as they met him. Then the LORD's Spirit came mightily on him, and the ropes that were on his arms became as flax that was burned with fire; and his bands dropped from off his hands. ¹⁵He found a fresh jawbone of a donkey, put out his hand, took it, and struck a thousand men with it. ¹⁶Samson said, "With the jawbone of a donkey, heaps on heaps; with the jawbone of a donkey I have struck a thousand men." ¹⁷When he had finished speaking, he threw the jawbone out of his hand; and that place was called Ramath Lehi. ^{xxi} ¹⁸He was very thirsty, and called on the LORD and said, "You have given this great deliverance by the hand of your servant; and now shall I die of thirst, and fall into the hands of the uncircumcised?" ¹⁹But God split the hollow place that is in Lehi, and wa-

ter came out of it. When he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived. Therefore its name was called En Hakkore, which is in Lehi, to this day. ²⁰He judged Israel twenty years in the days of the Philistines.

¹⁶Samson went to Gaza, and saw there a prostitute, and went in to her. ²The Gazites were told, "Samson is here!" They surrounded him and laid wait for him all night in the gate of the city, and were quiet all the night, saying, "Wait until morning light; then we will kill him." ³Samson lay until midnight, then arose at midnight and took hold of the doors of the gate of the city, with the two posts, and plucked them up, bar and all, and put them on his shoulders and carried them up to the top of the mountain that is before Hebron. ⁴It came to pass afterward that he loved a woman in the valley of Sorek, whose name was Delilah. ⁵The lords of the Philistines came up to her and said to her, "Entice him, and see in which his great strength lies, and by what means we may prevail against him, that we may bind him to afflict him; and we will each give you eleven hundred pieces of silver." ⁶Delilah said to Samson, "Please tell me where your great strength lies, and what you might be bound to afflict you." ⁷Samson said to her, "If they bind me with seven green cords that were never dried, then shall I become weak, and be as another man." ⁸Then the lords of the Philistines brought up to her seven green cords which had not been dried, and she bound him with them. ⁹Now she had an ambush waiting in the inner room. She said to him, "The Philistines are on you, Samson!" He broke the cords as a flax thread is broken when it touches the fire. So his strength was not known. ¹⁰Delilah said to Samson, "Behold, you have mocked me, and told me lies. Now please tell me how you might be bound." ¹¹He said to her, "If they only bind me with new ropes with which no work has been done, then shall I become weak, and be as another man." ¹²So Delilah took new ropes and bound him with them, then said to him, "The Philistines are on you, Samson!" The ambush was waiting in the inner room. He broke them off his arms like a thread. ¹³Delilah said to Samson, "Until now, you have mocked me and told me lies. Tell me with what you might be bound." He said to her, "If you weave the seven locks of my head with the fabric on the loom." ¹⁴She fastened it with the pin, and said to him, "The Philistines are on you, Samson!" He awakened out of his sleep, and plucked away the pin of the beam and the fabric. ¹⁵She said to him, "How can you say, 'I love you,' when your heart is not with me? You have mocked me these three times, and have not told me where your great strength lies." ¹⁶When she pressed him daily with her words and urged him, his soul was troubled to death. ¹⁷He told her all his heart and said to her, "No razor has ever come on my head; for I have been a Nazirite to God from my mother's womb. If I am shaved, then my strength will go from me and I

^{xxi}"Ramath" means "hill" and "Lehi" means "jawbone".

will become weak, and be like any other man.”¹⁸ When Delilah saw that he had told her all his heart, she sent and called for the lords of the Philistines, saying, “Come up this once, for he has told me all his heart.” Then the lords of the Philistines came up to her and brought the money in their hand.¹⁹ She made him sleep on her knees; and she called for a man and shaved off the seven locks of his head; and she began to afflict him, and his strength went from him.²⁰ She said, “The Philistines are upon you, Samson!” He awoke out of his sleep, and said, “I will go out as at other times, and shake myself free.” But he didn’t know that the LORD had departed from him.²¹ The Philistines laid hold on him and put out his eyes; and they brought him down to Gaza and bound him with fetters of bronze; and he ground at the mill in the prison.²² However, the hair of his head began to grow again after he was shaved.²³ The lords of the Philistines gathered together to offer a great sacrifice to Dagon their god, and to rejoice; for they said, “Our god has delivered Samson our enemy into our hand.”²⁴ When the people saw him, they praised their god; for they said, “Our god has delivered our enemy and the destroyer of our country, who has slain many of us, into our hand.”²⁵ When their hearts were merry, they said, “Call for Samson, that he may entertain us.” They called for Samson out of the prison; and he performed before them. They set him between the pillars;²⁶ and Samson said to the boy who held him by the hand, “Allow me to feel the pillars on which the house rests, that I may lean on them.”²⁷ Now the house was full of men and women; and all the lords of the Philistines were there; and there were on the roof about three thousand men and women, who saw while Samson performed.²⁸ Samson called to the LORD, and said, “Lord GOD, remember me, please, and strengthen me, please, only this once, God, that I may be at once avenged of the Philistines for my two eyes.”²⁹ Samson took hold of the two middle pillars on which the house rested and leaned on them, the one with his right hand and the other with his left.³⁰ Samson said, “Let me die with the Philistines!” He bowed himself with all his might; and the house fell on the lords, and on all the people who were in it. So the dead that he killed at his death were more than those who he killed in his life.³¹ Then his brothers and all the house of his father came down and took him, and brought him up and buried him between Zorah and Eshtaol in the burial site of Manoah his father. He judged Israel twenty years.

17 There was a man of the hill country of Ephraim, whose name was Micah.² He said to his mother, “The eleven hundred pieces of silver that were taken from you, about which you uttered a curse, and also spoke it in my ears—behold, the silver is with me. I took it.” His mother said, “May the LORD bless my son!”³ He restored the eleven hundred pieces of silver to his mother, then his

mother said, “I most certainly dedicate the silver to the LORD from my hand for my son, to make a carved image and a molten image. Now therefore I will restore it to you.”⁴ When he restored the money to his mother, his mother took two hundred pieces of silver, and gave them to a silversmith, who made a carved image and a molten image out of it. It was in the house of Micah.⁵ The man Micah had a house of gods, and he made an ephod, and teraphim,^{xxii} and consecrated one of his sons, who became his priest.⁶ In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did that which was right in his own eyes.⁷ There was a young man out of Bethlehem Judah, of the family of Judah, who was a Levite; and he lived there.⁸ The man departed out of the city, out of Bethlehem Judah, to live where he could find a place, and he came to the hill country of Ephraim, to the house of Micah, as he traveled.⁹ Micah said to him, “Where did you come from?” He said to him, “I am a Levite of Bethlehem Judah, and I am looking for a place to live.”¹⁰ Micah said to him, “Dwell with me, and be to me a father and a priest, and I will give you ten pieces of silver per year, a suit of clothing, and your food.” So the Levite went in.¹¹ The Levite was content to dwell with the man; and the young man was to him as one of his sons.¹² Micah consecrated the Levite, and the young man became his priest, and was in the house of Micah.¹³ Then Micah said, “Now I know that the LORD will do good to me, since I have a Levite as my priest.”

18 In those days there was no king in Israel. In those days the tribe of the Danites sought an inheritance to dwell in; for to that day, their inheritance had not fallen to them among the tribes of Israel.² The children of Dan sent five men of their family from their whole number, men of valor, from Zorah and from Eshtaol, to spy out the land and to search it. They said to them, “Go, explore the land!” They came to the hill country of Ephraim, to the house of Micah, and lodged there.³ When they were by the house of Micah, they knew the voice of the young man the Levite; so they went over there and said to him, “Who brought you here? What do you do in this place? What do you have here?”⁴ He said to them, “Thus and thus has Micah dealt with me, and he has hired me, and I have become his priest.”⁵ They said to him, “Please ask counsel of God, that we may know whether our way which we go shall be prosperous.”⁶ The priest said to them, “Go in peace. Your way in which you go is before the LORD.”⁷ Then the five men departed and came to Laish and saw the people who were there, how they lived in safety, in the way of the Sidonians, quiet and secure; for there was no one in the land possessing authority, that might put them to shame in anything, and they were far from the Sidonians, and had no dealings with anyone else.⁸ They came to their

^{xxii}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

brothers at Zorah and Eshtaol; and their brothers asked them, "What do you say?" ⁹They said, "Arise, and let's go up against them; for we have seen the land, and behold, it is very good. Do you stand still? Don't be slothful to go and to enter in to possess the land." ¹⁰When you go, you will come to an unsuspecting people, and the land is large; for God has given it into your hand, a place where there is no lack of anything that is in the earth." ¹¹The family of the Danites set out from Zorah and Eshtaol with six hundred men armed with weapons of war. ¹²They went up and encamped in Kiriath Jearim in Judah. Therefore they call that place Mahaneh Dan to this day. Behold, it is behind Kiriath Jearim. ¹³They passed from there to the hill country of Ephraim, and came to the house of Micah. ¹⁴Then the five men who went to spy out the country of Laish answered and said to their brothers, "Do you know that there is in these houses an ephod, and teraphim, ^{xxiii} and a carved image, and a molten image? Now therefore consider what you have to do." ¹⁵They went over there and came to the house of the young Levite man, even to the house of Micah, and asked him how he was doing. ¹⁶The six hundred men armed with their weapons of war, who were of the children of Dan, stood by the entrance of the gate. ¹⁷The five men who went to spy out the land went up, and came in there, and took the engraved image, the ephod, the teraphim, and the molten image; and the priest stood by the entrance of the gate with the six hundred men armed with weapons of war. ¹⁸When these went into Micah's house, and took the engraved image, the ephod, the teraphim, and the molten image, the priest said to them, "What are you doing?" ¹⁹They said to him, "Hold your peace, put your hand on your mouth, and go with us. Be a father and a priest to us. Is it better for you to be priest to the house of one man, or to be priest to a tribe and a family in Israel?" ²⁰The priest's heart was glad, and he took the ephod, the teraphim, and the engraved image, and went with the people. ²¹So they turned and departed, and put the little ones, the livestock, and the goods before them. ²²When they were a good way from the house of Micah, the men who were in the houses near Micah's house gathered together and overtook the children of Dan. ²³As they called to the children of Dan, they turned their faces, and said to Micah, "What ails you, that you come with such a company?" ²⁴He said, "You have taken away my gods which I made, and the priest, and have gone away! What more do I have? How can you ask me, 'What ails you?'" ²⁵The children of Dan said to him, "Don't let your voice be heard among us, lest angry fellows fall on you, and you lose your life, with the lives of your household." ²⁶The children of Dan went their way; and when Micah saw that they were too strong for him, he turned and went back to his house. ²⁷They took that which Micah had made, and

the priest whom he had, and came to Laish, to a people quiet and unsuspecting, and struck them with the edge of the sword; then they burned the city with fire. ²⁸There was no deliverer, because it was far from Sidon, and they had no dealings with anyone else; and it was in the valley that lies by Beth Rehob. They built the city and lived in it. ²⁹They called the name of the city Dan, after the name of Dan their father, who was born to Israel; however the name of the city used to be Laish. ³⁰The children of Dan set up for themselves the engraved image; and Jonathan, the son of Gershom, the son of Moses, and his sons were priests to the tribe of the Danites until the day of the captivity of the land. ³¹So they set up for themselves Micah's engraved image which he made, and it remained all the time that God's house was in Shiloh.

19In those days, when there was no king in Israel, there was a certain Levite living on the farther side of the hill country of Ephraim, who took for himself a concubine out of Bethlehem Judah. ²His concubine played the prostitute against him, and went away from him to her father's house to Bethlehem Judah, and was there for four months. ³Her husband arose and went after her to speak kindly to her, to bring her again, having his servant with him and a couple of donkeys. She brought him into her father's house; and when the father of the young lady saw him, he rejoiced to meet him. ⁴His father-in-law, the young lady's father, kept him there; and he stayed with him three days. So they ate and drank, and stayed there. ⁵On the fourth day, they got up early in the morning, and he rose up to depart. The young lady's father said to his son-in-law, "Strengthen your heart with a morsel of bread, and afterward you shall go your way." ⁶So they sat down, ate, and drank, both of them together. Then the young lady's father said to the man, "Please be pleased to stay all night, and let your heart be merry." ⁷The man rose up to depart; but his father-in-law urged him, and he stayed there again. ⁸He arose early in the morning on the fifth day to depart; and the young lady's father said, "Please strengthen your heart and stay until the day declines;" and they both ate. ⁹When the man rose up to depart, he, and his concubine, and his servant, his father-in-law, the young lady's father, said to him, "Behold, now the day draws toward evening, please stay all night. Behold, the day is ending. Stay here, that your heart may be merry; and tomorrow go on your way early, that you may go home." ¹⁰But the man wouldn't stay that night, but he rose up and went near Jebus (also called Jerusalem). With him were a couple of saddled donkeys. His concubine also was with him. ¹¹When they were by Jebus, the day was far spent; and the servant said to his master, "Please come and let's enter into this city of the Jebusites, and stay in it." ¹²His master said to him, "We won't enter into the city of a foreigner that is not of the children of Israel; but we will pass over to Gibeah." ¹³He

^{xxiii}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

said to his servant, "Come and let's draw near to one of these places; and we will lodge in Gibeah, or in Ramah."

¹⁴So they passed on and went their way; and the sun went down on them near Gibeah, which belongs to Benjamin.

¹⁵They went over there, to go in to stay in Gibeah. He went in, and sat down in the street of the city; for there was no one who took them into his house to stay. ¹⁶Behold, an old man came from his work out of the field at evening. Now the man was from the hill country of Ephraim, and he lived in Gibeah; but the men of the place were Benjamites.

¹⁷He lifted up his eyes, and saw the wayfaring man in the street of the city; and the old man said, "Where are you going? Where did you come from?" ¹⁸He said to him, "We are passing from Bethlehem Judah to the farther side of the hill country of Ephraim. I am from there, and I went to Bethlehem Judah. I am going to the LORD's house; and there is no one who has taken me into his house. ¹⁹Yet there is both straw and feed for our donkeys; and there is bread and wine also for me, and for your servant, and for the young man who is with your servants. There is no lack of anything."

²⁰The old man said, "Peace be to you! Just let me supply all your needs, but don't sleep in the street." ²¹So he brought him into his house, and gave the donkeys fodder. Then they washed their feet, and ate and drank. ²²As they were making their hearts merry, behold, the men of the city, certain wicked fellows, surrounded the house, beating at the door; and they spoke to the master of the house, the old man, saying, "Bring out the man who came into your house, that we can have sex with him!"

²³The man, the master of the house, went out to them, and said to them, "No, my brothers, please don't act so wickedly; since this man has come into my house, don't do this folly. ²⁴Behold, here is my virgin daughter and his concubine. I will bring them out now. Humble them, and do with them what seems good to you; but to this man don't do any such folly." ²⁵But the men wouldn't listen to him; so the man grabbed his concubine, and brought her out to them; and they had sex with her, and abused her all night until the morning. When the day began to dawn, they let her go. ²⁶Then the woman came in the dawning of the day, and fell down at the door of the man's house where her lord was, until it was light. ²⁷Her lord rose up in the morning and opened the doors of the house, and went out to go his way; and behold, the woman his concubine had fallen down at the door of the house, with her hands on the threshold. ²⁸He said to her, "Get up, and let's get going!" but no one answered. Then he took her up on the donkey; and the man rose up, and went to his place. ²⁹When he had come into his house, he took a knife and cut up his concubine, and divided her, limb by limb, into twelve pieces, and sent her throughout all the borders of Israel. ³⁰It was so, that all who saw it said, "Such a deed has not been done or seen from the day that the children of Israel came up out of the land of Egypt to this day!

Consider it, take counsel, and speak."

20Then all the children of Israel went out, and the congregation was assembled as one man, from Dan even to Beersheba, with the land of Gilead, to the LORD at Mizpah. ²The chiefs of all the people, even of all the tribes of Israel, presented themselves in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen who drew sword.

³(Now the children of Benjamin heard that the children of Israel had gone up to Mizpah.) The children of Israel said, "Tell us, how did this wickedness happen?" ⁴The Levite, the husband of the woman who was murdered, answered, "I came into Gibeah that belongs to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to spend the night. ⁵The men of Gibeah rose against me, and surrounded the house by night. They intended to kill me and they raped my concubine, and she is dead. ⁶I took my concubine and cut her in pieces, and sent her throughout all the country of the inheritance of Israel; for they have committed lewdness and folly in Israel. ⁷Behold, you children of Israel, all of you, give here your advice and counsel." ⁸All the people arose as one man, saying, "None of us will go to his tent, neither will any of us turn to his house. ⁹But now this is the thing which we will do to Gibeah: we will go up against it by lot; ¹⁰and we will take ten men of one hundred throughout all the tribes of Israel, and one hundred of one thousand, and a thousand out of ten thousand to get food for the people, that they may do, when they come to Gibeah of Benjamin, according to all the folly that the men of Gibeah have done in Israel." ¹¹So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, knit together as one man. ¹²The tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, "What wickedness is this that has happened among you? ¹³Now therefore deliver up the men, the wicked fellows who are in Gibeah, that we may put them to death and put away evil from Israel." But Benjamin would not listen to the voice of their brothers, the children of Israel. ¹⁴The children of Benjamin gathered themselves together out of the cities to Gibeah, to go out to battle against the children of Israel. ¹⁵The children of Benjamin were counted on that day out of the cities twenty-six thousand men who drew the sword, in addition to the inhabitants of Gibeah, who were counted seven hundred chosen men. ¹⁶Among all these soldiers there were seven hundred chosen men who were left-handed. Every one of them could sling a stone at a hair and not miss. ¹⁷The men of Israel, besides Benjamin, were counted four hundred thousand men who drew sword. All these were men of war. ¹⁸The children of Israel arose, went up to Bethel, and asked counsel of God. They asked, "Who shall go up for us first to battle against the children of Benjamin?" The LORD said, "Judah first." ¹⁹The children of Israel rose up in the morning and encamped against Gibeah. ²⁰The men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin; and the men of Israel set the battle in

array against them at Gibeah. ²¹The children of Benjamin came out of Gibeah, and on that day destroyed twenty-two thousand of the Israelite men down to the ground. ²²The people, the men of Israel, encouraged themselves, and set the battle again in array in the place where they set themselves in array the first day. ²³The children of Israel went up and wept before the LORD until evening; and they asked of the LORD, saying, "Shall I again draw near to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother?" The LORD said, "Go up against him." ²⁴The children of Israel came near against the children of Benjamin the second day. ²⁵Benjamin went out against them out of Gibeah the second day, and destroyed down to the ground of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men. All these drew the sword. ²⁶Then all the children of Israel and all the people went up, and came to Bethel, and wept, and sat there before the LORD, and fasted that day until evening; then they offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD. ²⁷The children of Israel asked the LORD (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days, ²⁸and Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days), saying, "Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease?" The LORD said, "Go up; for tomorrow I will deliver him into your hand." ²⁹Israel set ambushes all around Gibeah. ³⁰The children of Israel went up against the children of Benjamin on the third day, and set themselves in array against Gibeah, as at other times. ³¹The children of Benjamin went out against the people, and were drawn away from the city; and they began to strike and kill of the people as at other times, in the highways, of which one goes up to Bethel and the other to Gibeah, in the field, about thirty men of Israel. ³²The children of Benjamin said, "They are struck down before us, as at the first." But the children of Israel said, "Let's flee, and draw them away from the city to the highways." ³³All the men of Israel rose up out of their place and set themselves in array at Baal Tamar. Then the ambushers of Israel broke out of their place, even out of Maareh Geba. ³⁴Ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel came over against Gibeah, and the battle was severe; but they didn't know that disaster was close to them. ³⁵The LORD struck Benjamin before Israel; and the children of Israel destroyed of Benjamin that day twenty-five thousand one hundred men. All these drew the sword. ³⁶So the children of Benjamin saw that they were struck, for the men of Israel yielded to Benjamin because they trusted the ambushers whom they had set against Gibeah. ³⁷The ambushers hurried, and rushed on Gibeah; then the ambushers spread out, and struck all the city with the edge of the sword. ³⁸Now the appointed sign between the men of Israel and the ambushers was that they should make a great cloud of smoke rise up out of the city. ³⁹The men of Israel turned in the battle, and Benjamin began to strike and kill of the men of Israel about thirty persons;

for they said, "Surely they are struck down before us, as in the first battle." ⁴⁰But when the cloud began to arise up out of the city in a pillar of smoke, the Benjamites looked behind them; and behold, the whole city went up in smoke to the sky. ⁴¹The men of Israel turned, and the men of Benjamin were dismayed; for they saw that disaster had come on them. ⁴²Therefore they turned their backs before the men of Israel to the way of the wilderness, but the battle followed hard after them; and those who came out of the cities destroyed them in the middle of it. ⁴³They surrounded the Benjamites, chased them, and trod them down at their resting place, as far as near Gibeah toward the sunrise. ⁴⁴Eighteen thousand men of Benjamin fell; all these were men of valor. ⁴⁵They turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon. They gleaned five thousand men of them in the highways, and followed hard after them to Gidom, and struck two thousand men of them. ⁴⁶So that all who fell that day of Benjamin were twenty-five thousand men who drew the sword. All these were men of valor. ⁴⁷But six hundred men turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon, and stayed in the rock of Rimmon four months. ⁴⁸The men of Israel turned again on the children of Benjamin, and struck them with the edge of the sword—including the entire city, the livestock, and all that they found. Moreover they set all the cities which they found on fire.

²¹Now the men of Israel had sworn in Mizpah, saying, "None of us will give his daughter to Benjamin as a wife." ²The people came to Bethel and sat there until evening before God, and lifted up their voices, and wept severely. ³They said, "The LORD, the God of Israel, why has this happened in Israel, that there should be one tribe lacking in Israel today?" ⁴On the next day, the people rose early and built an altar there, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. ⁵The children of Israel said, "Who is there among all the tribes of Israel who didn't come up in the assembly to the LORD?" For they had made a great oath concerning him who didn't come up to the LORD to Mizpah, saying, "He shall surely be put to death." ⁶The children of Israel grieved for Benjamin their brother, and said, "There is one tribe cut off from Israel today. ⁷How shall we provide wives for those who remain, since we have sworn by the LORD that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?" ⁸They said, "What one is there of the tribes of Israel who didn't come up to the LORD to Mizpah?" Behold, no one came from Jabesh Gilead to the camp to the assembly. ⁹For when the people were counted, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead there. ¹⁰The congregation sent twelve thousand of the most valiant men there, and commanded them, saying, "Go and strike the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the little ones. ¹¹This is the thing that you shall do: you

shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman who has lain with a man.” ¹²They found among the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead four hundred young virgins who had not known man by lying with him; and they brought them to the camp to Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan. ¹³The whole congregation sent and spoke to the children of Benjamin who were in the rock of Rimmon, and proclaimed peace to them. ¹⁴Benjamin returned at that time; and they gave them the women whom they had saved alive of the women of Jabesh Gilead. There still weren’t enough for them. ¹⁵The people grieved for Benjamin, because the LORD had made a breach in the tribes of Israel. ¹⁶Then the elders of the congregation said, “How shall we provide wives for those who remain, since the women are destroyed out of Benjamin?” ¹⁷They said, “There must be an inheritance for those who are escaped of Benjamin, that a tribe not be blotted out from Israel. ¹⁸However, we may not give them wives of our daughters, for the children of Israel had sworn, saying, ‘Cursed is he who gives a wife to Benjamin.’” ¹⁹They said, “Behold, there is a feast of the LORD from year to year in Shiloh, which is on the north of Bethel, on the east side of the highway that goes up from Bethel to Shechem, and on the south of Lebonah.” ²⁰They commanded the children of Benjamin, saying, “Go and lie in wait in the vineyards, ²¹and see, and behold, if the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance in the dances, then come out of the vineyards, and each man catch his wife of the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin. ²²It shall be, when their fathers or their brothers come to complain to us, that we will say to them, ‘Grant them graciously to us, because we didn’t take for each man his wife in battle, neither did you give them to them; otherwise you would now be guilty.’” ²³The children of Benjamin did so, and took wives for themselves according to their number, of those who danced, whom they carried off. They went and returned to their inheritance, built the cities, and lived in them. ²⁴The children of Israel departed from there at that time, every man to his tribe and to his family, and they each went out from there to his own inheritance. ²⁵In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did that which was right in his own eyes.

Ruth

¹In the days when the judges judged, there was a famine in the land. A certain man of Bethlehem Judah went to live in the country of Moab with his wife and his two sons. ²The name of the man was Elimelech, and the name of his wife Naomi. The names of his two sons were Mahlon and Chilion, Ephrathites of Bethlehem Judah. They came into the country of Moab and lived there. ³Elimelech, Naomi's husband, died; and she was left with her two sons. ⁴They took for themselves wives of the women of Moab. The name of the one was Orpah, and the name of the other was Ruth. They lived there about ten years. ⁵Mahlon and Chilion both died, and the woman was bereaved of her two children and of her husband. ⁶Then she arose with her daughters-in-law, that she might return from the country of Moab; for she had heard in the country of Moab how the LORD ⁱ had visited his people in giving them bread. ⁷She went out of the place where she was, and her two daughters-in-law with her. They went on the way to return to the land of Judah. ⁸Naomi said to her two daughters-in-law, "Go, return each of you to her mother's house. May the LORD deal kindly with you, as you have dealt with the dead and with me. ⁹May The LORD grant you that you may find rest, each of you in the house of her husband." Then she kissed them, and they lifted up their voices, and wept. ¹⁰They said to her, "No, but we will return with you to your people." ¹¹Naomi said, "Go back, my daughters. Why do you want to go with me? Do I still have sons in my womb, that they may be your husbands? ¹²Go back, my daughters, go your way; for I am too old to have a husband. If I should say, 'I have hope,' if I should even have a husband tonight, and should also bear sons, ¹³would you then wait until they were grown? Would you then refrain from having husbands? No, my daughters, for it grieves me seriously for your sakes, for the LORD's hand has gone out against me." ¹⁴They lifted up their voices and wept again; then Orpah kissed her mother-in-law, but Ruth stayed with her. ¹⁵She said, "Behold, ⁱⁱ your sister-in-law has gone back to her people and to her god. Follow your sister-in-law." ¹⁶Ruth said, "Don't urge me to leave

you, and to return from following you, for where you go, I will go; and where you stay, I will stay. Your people will be my people, and your God ⁱⁱⁱ my God. ¹⁷Where you die, I will die, and there I will be buried. May The LORD do so to me, and more also, if anything but death parts you and me." ¹⁸When Naomi saw that she was determined to go with her, she stopped urging her. ¹⁹So they both went until they came to Bethlehem. When they had come to Bethlehem, all the city was excited about them, and they asked, "Is this Naomi?" ²⁰She said to them, "Don't call me Naomi. ^{iv} Call me Mara, ^v for the Almighty has dealt very bitterly with me. ²¹I went out full, and the LORD has brought me home again empty. Why do you call me Naomi, since the LORD has testified against me, and the Almighty has afflicted me?" ²²So Naomi returned, and Ruth the Moabitess, her daughter-in-law, with her, who returned out of the country of Moab. They came to Bethlehem in the beginning of barley harvest.

²Naomi had a relative of her husband's, a mighty man of wealth, of the family of Elimelech, and his name was Boaz. ²Ruth the Moabitess said to Naomi, "Let me now go to the field, and glean among the ears of grain after him in whose sight I find favor." She said to her, "Go, my daughter." ³She went, and came and gleaned in the field after the reapers; and she happened to come to the portion of the field belonging to Boaz, who was of the family of Elimelech. ⁴Behold, Boaz came from Bethlehem, and said to the reapers, "May The LORD be with you." They answered him, "May The LORD bless you." ⁵Then Boaz said to his servant who was set over the reapers, "Whose young lady is this?" ⁶The servant who was set over the reapers answered, "It is the Moabite lady who came back with Naomi out of the country of Moab. ⁷She said, 'Please let me glean and gather after the reapers among the sheaves.' So she came, and has continued even from the morning until now, except that she rested a little in the house." ⁸Then Boaz said to Ruth, "Listen, my daughter. Don't go to glean in another field, and don't go from here, but stay here close to my maidens. ⁹Let your eyes be on the field

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^{iv}"Naomi" means "pleasant".

^v"Mara" means "bitter".

that they reap, and go after them. Haven't I commanded the young men not to touch you? When you are thirsty, go to the vessels, and drink from that which the young men have drawn." ¹⁰Then she fell on her face and bowed herself to the ground, and said to him, "Why have I found favor in your sight, that you should take knowledge of me, since I am a foreigner?" ¹¹Boaz answered her, "I have been told all about what you have done for your mother-in-law since the death of your husband, and how you have left your father, your mother, and the land of your birth, and have come to a people that you didn't know before. ¹²May the LORD repay your work, and a full reward be given to you from the LORD, the God of Israel, under whose wings you have come to take refuge." ¹³Then she said, "Let me find favor in your sight, my lord, because you have comforted me, and because you have spoken kindly to your servant, though I am not as one of your servants." ¹⁴At meal time Boaz said to her, "Come here, and eat some bread, and dip your morsel in the vinegar." She sat beside the reapers, and they passed her parched grain. She ate, was satisfied, and left some of it. ¹⁵When she had risen up to glean, Boaz commanded his young men, saying, "Let her glean even among the sheaves, and don't reproach her. ¹⁶Also pull out some for her from the bundles, and leave it. Let her glean, and don't rebuke her." ¹⁷So she gleaned in the field until evening; and she beat out that which she had gleaned, and it was about an ephah ^{vi} of barley. ¹⁸She took it up, and went into the city. Then her mother-in-law saw what she had gleaned; and she brought out and gave to her that which she had left after she had enough. ¹⁹Her mother-in-law said to her, "Where have you gleaned today? Where have you worked? Blessed be he who noticed you." She told her mother-in-law with whom she had worked, "The man's name with whom I worked today is Boaz." ²⁰Naomi said to her daughter-in-law, "May he be blessed by the LORD, who has not abandoned his kindness to the living and to the dead." Naomi said to her, "The man is a close relative to us, one of our near kinsmen." ²¹Ruth the Moabitess said, "Yes, he said to me, 'You shall stay close to my young men until they have finished all my harvest.'" ²²Naomi said to Ruth her daughter-in-law, "It is good, my daughter, that you go out with his maidens, and that they not meet you in any other field." ²³So she stayed close to the maidens of Boaz, to glean to the end of barley harvest and of wheat harvest; and she lived with her mother-in-law.

³Naomi her mother-in-law said to her, "My daughter, shall I not seek rest for you, that it may be well with you? ²Now isn't Boaz our kinsman, with whose maidens you were? Behold, he will be winnowing barley tonight on the threshing floor. ³Therefore wash yourself, anoint yourself, get dressed, and go down to the threshing floor;

but don't make yourself known to the man until he has finished eating and drinking. ⁴It shall be, when he lies down, that you shall note the place where he is lying. Then you shall go in, uncover his feet, and lie down. Then he will tell you what to do." ⁵She said to her, "All that you say, I will do." ⁶She went down to the threshing floor, and did everything that her mother-in-law told her. ⁷When Boaz had eaten and drunk, and his heart was merry, he went to lie down at the end of the heap of grain. She came softly, uncovered his feet, and lay down. ⁸At midnight, the man was startled and turned himself; and behold, a woman lay at his feet. ⁹He said, "Who are you?" She answered, "I am Ruth your servant. Therefore spread the corner of your garment over your servant; for you are a near kinsman." ¹⁰He said, "You are blessed by the LORD, my daughter. You have shown more kindness in the latter end than at the beginning, because you didn't follow young men, whether poor or rich. ¹¹Now, my daughter, don't be afraid. I will do to you all that you say; for all the city of my people knows that you are a worthy woman. ¹²Now it is true that I am a near kinsman. However, there is a kinsman nearer than I. ¹³Stay this night, and in the morning, if he will perform for you the part of a kinsman, good. Let him do the kinsman's duty. But if he will not do the duty of a kinsman for you, then I will do the duty of a kinsman for you, as the LORD lives. Lie down until the morning." ¹⁴She lay at his feet until the morning, then she rose up before one could discern another. For he said, "Let it not be known that the woman came to the threshing floor." ¹⁵He said, "Bring the mantle that is on you, and hold it." She held it; and he measured six measures of barley, and laid it on her; then he went into the city. ¹⁶When she came to her mother-in-law, she said, "How did it go, my daughter?" She told her all that the man had done for her. ¹⁷She said, "He gave me these six measures of barley; for he said, 'Don't go empty to your mother-in-law.'" ¹⁸Then she said, "Wait, my daughter, until you know what will happen; for the man will not rest until he has settled this today."

⁴Now Boaz went up to the gate and sat down there. Behold, the near kinsman of whom Boaz spoke came by. Boaz said to him, "Come over here, friend, and sit down!" He came over, and sat down. ²Boaz took ten men of the elders of the city, and said, "Sit down here," and they sat down. ³He said to the near kinsman, "Naomi, who has come back out of the country of Moab, is selling the parcel of land, which was our brother Elimelech's. ⁴I thought I should tell you, saying, 'Buy it before those who sit here, and before the elders of my people.' If you will redeem it, redeem it; but if you will not redeem it, then tell me, that I may know. For there is no one to redeem it besides you; and I am after you." He said, "I will redeem it." ⁵Then Boaz said, "On the day you buy the field from the hand of

^{vi}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

Naomi, you must buy it also from Ruth the Moabitess, the wife of the dead, to raise up the name of the dead on his inheritance.” ⁶The near kinsman said, “I can’t redeem it for myself, lest I endanger my own inheritance. Take my right of redemption for yourself; for I can’t redeem it.” ⁷Now this was the custom in former time in Israel concerning redeeming and concerning exchanging, to confirm all things: a man took off his sandal, and gave it to his neighbor; and this was the way of formalizing transactions in Israel. ⁸So the near kinsman said to Boaz, “Buy it for yourself,” then he took off his sandal. ⁹Boaz said to the elders and to all the people, “You are witnesses today, that I have bought all that was Elimelech’s, and all that was Chilion’s and Mahlon’s, from the hand of Naomi. ¹⁰Moreover, Ruth the Moabitess, the wife of Mahlon, I have purchased to be my wife, to raise up the name of the dead on his inheritance, that the name of the dead may not be cut off from among his brothers and from the gate of his place. You are witnesses today.” ¹¹All the people who were in the gate, and the elders, said, “We are witnesses. May the LORD make the woman who has come into your house like Rachel and like Leah, which both built the house of Israel; and treat you worthily in Ephrathah, and be famous in Bethlehem. ¹²Let your house be like the house of Perez, whom Tamar bore to Judah, of the offspring ^{vii} which the LORD will give you by this young woman.” ¹³So Boaz took Ruth and she became his wife; and he went in to her, and the LORD enabled her to conceive, and she bore a son. ¹⁴The women said to Naomi, “Blessed be the LORD, who has not left you today without a near kinsman. Let his name be famous in Israel. ¹⁵He shall be to you a restorer of life and sustain you in your old age; for your daughter-in-law, who loves you, who is better to you than seven sons, has given birth to him.” ¹⁶Naomi took the child, laid him in her bosom, and became nurse to him. ¹⁷The women, her neighbors, gave him a name, saying, “A son is born to Naomi”. They named him Obed. He is the father of Jesse, the father of David. ¹⁸Now this is the history of the generations of Perez: Perez became the father of Hezron, ¹⁹and Hezron became the father of Ram, and Ram became the father of Amminadab, ²⁰and Amminadab became the father of Nahshon, and Nahshon became the father of Salmon, ²¹and Salmon became the father of Boaz, and Boaz became the father of Obed, ²²and Obed became the father of Jesse, and Jesse became the father of David.

^{vii}or, seed

1 Samuel

¹Now there was a certain man of Ramathaim Zophim, of the hill country of Ephraim, and his name was Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Elihu, the son of Tohu, the son of Zuph, an Ephraimite. ²He had two wives. The name of one was Hannah, and the name of the other Peninnah. Peninnah had children, but Hannah had no children. ³This man went up out of his city from year to year to worship and to sacrifice to the LORD ⁱ of Hosts in Shiloh. The two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, priests to the LORD, were there. ⁴When the day came that Elkanah sacrificed, he gave portions to Peninnah his wife and to all her sons and her daughters; ⁵but he gave a double portion to Hannah, for he loved Hannah, but the LORD had shut up her womb. ⁶Her rival provoked her severely, to irritate her, because the LORD had shut up her womb. ⁷So year by year, when she went up to the LORD's house, her rival provoked her. Therefore she wept, and didn't eat. ⁸Elkanah her husband said to her, "Hannah, why do you weep? Why don't you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I not better to you than ten sons?" ⁹So Hannah rose up after they had finished eating and drinking in Shiloh. Now Eli the priest was sitting on his seat by the doorpost of the LORD's temple. ¹⁰She was in bitterness of soul, and prayed to the LORD, weeping bitterly. ¹¹She vowed a vow, and said, "LORD of Hosts, if you will indeed look at the affliction of your servant and remember me, and not forget your servant, but will give to your servant a boy, then I will give him to the LORD all the days of his life, and no razor shall come on his head." ¹²As she continued praying before the LORD, Eli saw her mouth. ¹³Now Hannah spoke in her heart. Only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard. Therefore Eli thought she was drunk. ¹⁴Eli said to her, "How long will you be drunk? Get rid of your wine!" ¹⁵Hannah answered, "No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have not been drinking wine or strong drink, but I poured out my soul before the LORD. ¹⁶Don't consider your servant a wicked woman; for I have been speaking out of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation." ¹⁷Then Eli answered, "Go in peace; and

may the God ⁱⁱ of Israel grant your petition that you have asked of him." ¹⁸She said, "Let your servant find favor in your sight." So the woman went her way and ate; and her facial expression wasn't sad any more. ¹⁹They rose up in the morning early and worshiped the LORD, then returned and came to their house to Ramah. Then Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and the LORD remembered her. ²⁰When the time had come, Hannah conceived, and bore a son; and she named him Samuel, ⁱⁱⁱ saying, "Because I have asked him of the LORD." ²¹The man Elkanah, and all his house, went up to offer to the LORD the yearly sacrifice and his vow. ²²But Hannah didn't go up, for she said to her husband, "Not until the child is weaned; then I will bring him, that he may appear before the LORD, and stay there forever." ²³Elkanah her husband said to her, "Do what seems good to you. Wait until you have weaned him; only may the LORD establish his word." So the woman waited and nursed her son until she weaned him. ²⁴When she had weaned him, she took him up with her, with three bulls, and one efah ^{iv} of meal, and a container of wine, and brought him to the LORD's house in Shiloh. The child was young. ²⁵They killed the bull, and brought the child to Eli. ²⁶She said, "Oh, my lord, as your soul lives, my lord, I am the woman who stood by you here, praying to the LORD. ²⁷I prayed for this child, and the LORD has given me my petition which I asked of him. ²⁸Therefore I have also given him to the LORD. As long as he lives he is given to the LORD." He worshiped the LORD there.

²Hannah prayed, and said, "My heart exults in the LORD! My horn is exalted in the LORD. My mouth is enlarged over my enemies, because I rejoice in your salvation. ²There is no one as holy as the LORD, for there is no one besides you, nor is there any rock like our God. ³"Don't keep talking so exceedingly proudly. Don't let arrogance come out of your mouth, for the LORD is a God of knowledge. By him actions are weighed. ⁴"The bows of the mighty men are broken. Those who stumbled are armed with strength. ⁵Those who were full have hired themselves

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱSamuel sounds like the Hebrew for "heard by God."

^{iv}1 efah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

out for bread. Those who were hungry are satisfied. Yes, the barren has borne seven. She who has many children languishes. ⁶“The LORD kills and makes alive. He brings down to Sheol ^v and brings up. ⁷The LORD makes poor and makes rich. He brings low, he also lifts up. ⁸He raises up the poor out of the dust. He lifts up the needy from the dunghill to make them sit with princes and inherit the throne of glory. For the pillars of the earth are the LORD’s. He has set the world on them. ⁹He will keep the feet of his holy ones, but the wicked will be put to silence in darkness; for no man will prevail by strength. ¹⁰Those who strive with the LORD shall be broken to pieces. He will thunder against them in the sky. “The LORD will judge the ends of the earth. He will give strength to his king, and exalt the horn of his anointed.” ¹¹Elkanah went to Ramah to his house. The child served the LORD before Eli the priest. ¹²Now the sons of Eli were wicked men. They didn’t know the LORD. ¹³The custom of the priests with the people was that when anyone offered a sacrifice, the priest’s servant came while the meat was boiling, with a fork of three teeth in his hand; ¹⁴and he stabbed it into the pan, or kettle, or cauldron, or pot. The priest took all that the fork brought up for himself. They did this to all the Israelites who came there to Shiloh. ¹⁵Yes, before they burned the fat, the priest’s servant came, and said to the man who sacrificed, “Give meat to roast for the priest; for he will not accept boiled meat from you, but raw.” ¹⁶If the man said to him, “Let the fat be burned first, and then take as much as your soul desires;” then he would say, “No, but you shall give it to me now; and if not, I will take it by force.” ¹⁷The sin of the young men was very great before the LORD; for the men despised the LORD’s offering. ¹⁸But Samuel ministered before the LORD, being a child, clothed with a linen ephod. ¹⁹Moreover his mother made him a little robe, and brought it to him from year to year when she came up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice. ²⁰Eli blessed Elkanah and his wife, and said, “May The LORD give you offspring ^{vi} from this woman for the petition which was asked of the LORD.” Then they went to their own home. ²¹The LORD visited Hannah, and she conceived and bore three sons and two daughters. The child Samuel grew before the LORD. ²²Now Eli was very old; and he heard all that his sons did to all Israel, and how that they slept with the women who served at the door of the Tent of Meeting. ²³He said to them, “Why do you do such things? For I hear of your evil dealings from all these people. ²⁴No, my sons; for it is not a good report that I hear! You make the LORD’s people disobey. ²⁵If one man sins against another, God will judge him; but if a man sins against the LORD, who will intercede for him?” Notwithstanding, they didn’t listen to the voice of their father, because the LORD intended to kill them. ²⁶The

child Samuel grew on, and increased in favor both with the LORD and also with men. ²⁷A man of God came to Eli and said to him, “The LORD says, ‘Did I reveal myself to the house of your father when they were in Egypt in bondage to Pharaoh’s house? ²⁸Didn’t I choose him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to go up to my altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me? Didn’t I give to the house of your father all the offerings of the children of Israel made by fire? ²⁹Why do you kick at my sacrifice and at my offering, which I have commanded in my habitation, and honor your sons above me, to make yourselves fat with the best of all the offerings of Israel my people?’ ³⁰“Therefore the LORD, the God of Israel, says, ‘I said indeed that your house and the house of your father should walk before me forever.’ But now the LORD says, ‘Far be it from me; for those who honor me I will honor, and those who despise me will be cursed. ³¹Behold, ^{vii} the days come that I will cut off your arm and the arm of your father’s house, that there will not be an old man in your house. ³²You will see the affliction of my habitation, in all the wealth which I will give Israel. There shall not be an old man in your house forever. ³³The man of yours whom I don’t cut off from my altar will consume your eyes ^{viii} and grieve your heart. All the increase of your house will die in the flower of their age. ³⁴This will be the sign to you that will come on your two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas: in one day they will both die. ³⁵I will raise up a faithful priest for myself who will do according to that which is in my heart and in my mind. I will build him a sure house. He will walk before my anointed forever. ³⁶It will happen that everyone who is left in your house will come and bow down to him for a piece of silver and a loaf of bread, and will say, “Please put me into one of the priests’ offices, that I may eat a morsel of bread.””

3The child Samuel ministered to the LORD before Eli. The LORD’s word was rare in those days. There were not many visions, then. ²At that time, when Eli was laid down in his place (now his eyes had begun to grow dim, so that he could not see), ³and God’s lamp hadn’t yet gone out, and Samuel had laid down in the LORD’s temple where God’s ark was, ⁴The LORD called Samuel. He said, “Here I am.” ⁵He ran to Eli and said, “Here I am; for you called me.” He said, “I didn’t call. Lie down again.” He went and lay down. ⁶The LORD called yet again, “Samuel!” Samuel arose and went to Eli and said, “Here I am; for you called me.” He answered, “I didn’t call, my son. Lie down again.” ⁷Now Samuel didn’t yet know the LORD, neither was the LORD’s word yet revealed to him. ⁸The LORD called Samuel again the third time. He arose and went to Eli and said, “Here I am; for you called me.” Eli perceived

^vSheol is the place of the dead.

^{vi}or, seed

^{vii}“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{viii}or, blind your eyes with tears

that the LORD had called the child. ⁹Therefore Eli said to Samuel, "Go, lie down. It shall be, if he calls you, that you shall say, 'Speak, LORD; for your servant hears.'" So Samuel went and lay down in his place. ¹⁰The LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, "Samuel! Samuel!" Then Samuel said, "Speak; for your servant hears." ¹¹The LORD said to Samuel, "Behold, I will do a thing in Israel at which both the ears of everyone who hears it will tingle. ¹²In that day I will perform against Eli all that I have spoken concerning his house, from the beginning even to the end. ¹³For I have told him that I will judge his house forever for the iniquity which he knew, because his sons brought a curse on themselves, and he didn't restrain them. ¹⁴Therefore I have sworn to the house of Eli that the iniquity of Eli's house shall not be removed with sacrifice or offering forever." ¹⁵Samuel lay until the morning, and opened the doors of the LORD's house. Samuel was afraid to show Eli the vision. ¹⁶Then Eli called Samuel and said, "Samuel, my son!" He said, "Here I am." ¹⁷He said, "What is the thing that he has spoken to you? Please don't hide it from me. God do so to you, and more also, if you hide anything from me of all the things that he spoke to you." ¹⁸Samuel told him every bit, and hid nothing from him. He said, "It is the LORD. Let him do what seems good to him." ¹⁹Samuel grew, and the LORD was with him and let none of his words fall to the ground. ²⁰All Israel from Dan even to Beersheba knew that Samuel was established to be a prophet of the LORD. ²¹The LORD appeared again in Shiloh; for the LORD revealed himself to Samuel in Shiloh by the LORD's word.

⁴The word of Samuel came to all Israel. Now Israel went out against the Philistines to battle, and encamped beside Ebenezer; and the Philistines encamped in Aphek. ²The Philistines put themselves in array against Israel. When they joined battle, Israel was defeated by the Philistines, who killed about four thousand men of the army in the field. ³When the people had come into the camp, the elders of Israel said, "Why has the LORD defeated us today before the Philistines? Let's get the ark of the LORD's covenant out of Shiloh and bring it to us, that it may come among us and save us out of the hand of our enemies." ⁴So the people sent to Shiloh, and they brought from there the ark of the covenant of the LORD of Hosts, who sits above the cherubim; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there with the ark of the covenant of God. ⁵When the ark of the LORD's covenant came into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, so that the earth resounded. ⁶When the Philistines heard the noise of the shout, they said, "What does the noise of this great shout in the camp of the Hebrews mean?" They understood that the LORD's ark had come into the camp. ⁷The Philistines were afraid, for they said, "God has come into the camp." They said, "Woe to us! For there has not been such a

thing before. ⁸Woe to us! Who shall deliver us out of the hand of these mighty gods? These are the gods that struck the Egyptians with all kinds of plagues in the wilderness. ⁹Be strong and behave like men, O you Philistines, that you not be servants to the Hebrews, as they have been to you. Strengthen yourselves like men, and fight!" ¹⁰The Philistines fought, and Israel was defeated, and each man fled to his tent. There was a very great slaughter; for thirty thousand footmen of Israel fell. ¹¹God's ark was taken; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain. ¹²A man of Benjamin ran out of the army and came to Shiloh the same day, with his clothes torn and with dirt on his head. ¹³When he came, behold, Eli was sitting on his seat by the road watching, for his heart trembled for God's ark. When the man came into the city and told about it, all the city cried out. ¹⁴When Eli heard the noise of the crying, he said, "What does the noise of this tumult mean?" The man hurried, and came and told Eli. ¹⁵Now Eli was ninety-eight years old. His eyes were set, so that he could not see. ¹⁶The man said to Eli, "I am he who came out of the army, and I fled today out of the army." He said, "How did the matter go, my son?" ¹⁷He who brought the news answered, "Israel has fled before the Philistines, and there has been also a great slaughter among the people. Your two sons also, Hophni and Phinehas, are dead, and God's ark has been captured." ¹⁸When he made mention of God's ark, Eli fell from off his seat backward by the side of the gate; and his neck broke, and he died, for he was an old man and heavy. He had judged Israel forty years. ¹⁹His daughter-in-law, Phinehas' wife, was with child, near to giving birth. When she heard the news that God's ark was taken and that her father-in-law and her husband were dead, she bowed herself and gave birth; for her pains came on her. ²⁰About the time of her death the women who stood by her said to her, "Don't be afraid, for you have given birth to a son." But she didn't answer, neither did she regard it. ²¹She named the child Ichabod, ^{ix} saying, "The glory has departed from Israel!" because God's ark was taken, and because of her father-in-law and her husband. ²²She said, "The glory has departed from Israel; for God's ark has been taken."

⁵Now the Philistines had taken God's ark, and they brought it from Ebenezer to Ashdod. ²The Philistines took God's ark, and brought it into the house of Dagon and set it by Dagon. ³When the people of Ashdod arose early on the next day, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before the LORD's ark. They took Dagon and set him in his place again. ⁴When they arose early on the following morning, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before the LORD's ark; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off on the threshold. Only Dagon's torso was intact. ⁵Therefore nei-

^{ix}"Ichabod" means "no glory."

ther the priests of Dagon nor any who come into Dagon's house step on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod to this day. ⁶But the LORD's hand was heavy on the people of Ashdod, and he destroyed them and struck them with tumors, even Ashdod and its borders. ⁷When the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, "The ark of the God of Israel shall not stay with us, for his hand is severe on us and on Dagon our god." ⁸They sent therefore and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines, and said, "What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel?" They answered, "Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried over to Gath." They carried the ark of the God of Israel there. ⁹It was so, that after they had carried it there, the LORD's hand was against the city with a very great confusion; and he struck the men of the city, both small and great, so that tumors broke out on them. ¹⁰So they sent God's ark to Ekron. As God's ark came to Ekron, the Ekronites cried out, saying, "They have brought the ark of the God of Israel here to us, to kill us and our people." ¹¹They sent therefore and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines, and they said, "Send the ark of the God of Israel away, and let it go again to its own place, that it not kill us and our people." For there was a deadly panic throughout all the city. The hand of God was very heavy there. ¹²The men who didn't die were struck with the tumors; and the cry of the city went up to heaven.

⁶The LORD's ark was in the country of the Philistines seven months. ²The Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, saying, "What shall we do with the LORD's ark? Show us how we should send it to its place." ³They said, "If you send away the ark of the God of Israel, don't send it empty; but by all means return a trespass offering to him. Then you will be healed, and it will be known to you why his hand is not removed from you." ⁴Then they said, "What should the trespass offering be which we shall return to him?" They said, "Five golden tumors and five golden mice, for the number of the lords of the Philistines; for one plague was on you all, and on your lords. ⁵Therefore you shall make images of your tumors and images of your mice that mar the land; and you shall give glory to the God of Israel. Perhaps he will release his hand from you, from your gods, and from your land. ⁶Why then do you harden your hearts as the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? When he had worked wonderfully among them, didn't they let the people go, and they departed? ⁷"Now therefore take and prepare yourselves a new cart and two milk cows on which there has come no yoke; and tie the cows to the cart, and bring their calves home from them; ⁸and take the LORD's ark and lay it on the cart. Put the jewels of gold, which you return him for a trespass offering, in a box by its side; and send it away, that it may go. ⁹Behold, if it goes up by the way of its own border to Beth Shemesh, then he

has done us this great evil; but if not, then we shall know that it is not his hand that struck us. It was a chance that happened to us." ¹⁰The men did so, and took two milk cows and tied them to the cart, and shut up their calves at home. ¹¹They put the LORD's ark on the cart, and the box with the golden mice and the images of their tumors. ¹²The cows took the straight way by the way to Beth Shemesh. They went along the highway, lowing as they went, and didn't turn away to the right hand or to the left; and the lords of the Philistines went after them to the border of Beth Shemesh. ¹³The people of Beth Shemesh were reaping their wheat harvest in the valley; and they lifted up their eyes and saw the ark, and rejoiced to see it. ¹⁴The cart came into the field of Joshua of Beth Shemesh, and stood there, where there was a great stone. Then they split the wood of the cart and offered up the cows for a burnt offering to the LORD. ¹⁵The Levites took down the LORD's ark and the box that was with it, in which the jewels of gold were, and put them on the great stone; and the men of Beth Shemesh offered burnt offerings and sacrificed sacrifices the same day to the LORD. ¹⁶When the five lords of the Philistines had seen it, they returned to Ekron the same day. ¹⁷These are the golden tumors which the Philistines returned for a trespass offering to the LORD: for Ashdod one, for Gaza one, for Ashkelon one, for Gath one, for Ekron one; ¹⁸and the golden mice, according to the number of all the cities of the Philistines belonging to the five lords, both of fortified cities and of country villages, even to the great stone on which they set down the LORD's ark. That stone remains to this day in the field of Joshua of Beth Shemesh. ¹⁹He struck of the men of Beth Shemesh, because they had looked into the LORD's ark, he struck fifty thousand seventy of the men. Then the people mourned, because the LORD had struck the people with a great slaughter. ²⁰The men of Beth Shemesh said, "Who is able to stand before the LORD, this holy God? To whom shall he go up from us?" ²¹They sent messengers to the inhabitants of Kiriath Jearim, saying, "The Philistines have brought back the LORD's ark. Come down and bring it up to yourselves."

⁷The men of Kiriath Jearim came and took the LORD's ark, and brought it into Abinadab's house on the hill, and consecrated Eleazar his son to keep the LORD's ark. ²From the day that the ark stayed in Kiriath Jearim, the time was long—for it was twenty years; and all the house of Israel lamented after the LORD. ³Samuel spoke to all the house of Israel, saying, "If you are returning to the LORD with all your heart, then put away the foreign gods and the Ashtaroath from among you, and direct your hearts to the LORD, and serve him only; and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines." ⁴Then the children of Israel removed the Baals and the Ashtaroath, and served the LORD only. ⁵Samuel said, "Gather all Israel to Mizpah, and I

will pray to the LORD for you.” ⁶They gathered together to Mizpah, and drew water, and poured it out before the LORD, and fasted on that day, and said there, “We have sinned against the LORD.” Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpah. ⁷When the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together at Mizpah, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. When the children of Israel heard it, they were afraid of the Philistines. ⁸The children of Israel said to Samuel, “Don’t stop crying to the LORD our God for us, that he will save us out of the hand of the Philistines.” ⁹Samuel took a suckling lamb, and offered it for a whole burnt offering to the LORD. Samuel cried to the LORD for Israel, and the LORD answered him. ¹⁰As Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines came near to battle against Israel; but the LORD thundered with a great thunder on that day on the Philistines and confused them; and they were struck down before Israel. ¹¹The men of Israel went out of Mizpah and pursued the Philistines, and struck them until they came under Beth Kar. ¹²Then Samuel took a stone and set it between Mizpah and Shen, and called its name Ebenezer, ^x saying, “The LORD helped us until now.” ¹³So the Philistines were subdued, and they stopped coming within the border of Israel. The LORD’s hand was against the Philistines all the days of Samuel. ¹⁴The cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even to Gath; and Israel recovered its border out of the hand of the Philistines. There was peace between Israel and the Amorites. ¹⁵Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life. ¹⁶He went from year to year in a circuit to Bethel, Gilgal, and Mizpah; and he judged Israel in all those places. ¹⁷His return was to Ramah, for his house was there, and he judged Israel there; and he built an altar to the LORD there.

⁸When Samuel was old, he made his sons judges over Israel. ²Now the name of his firstborn was Joel, and the name of his second, Abijah. They were judges in Beersheba. ³His sons didn’t walk in his ways, but turned away after dishonest gain, took bribes, and perverted justice. ⁴Then all the elders of Israel gathered themselves together and came to Samuel to Ramah. ⁵They said to him, “Behold, you are old, and your sons don’t walk in your ways. Now make us a king to judge us like all the nations.” ⁶But the thing displeased Samuel when they said, “Give us a king to judge us.” Samuel prayed to the LORD. ⁷The LORD said to Samuel, “Listen to the voice of the people in all that they tell you; for they have not rejected you, but they have rejected me as the king over them. ⁸According to all the works which they have done since the day that I brought them up out of Egypt even to this day, in that they have forsaken me and served other gods, so they also do to you. ⁹Now therefore, listen to their voice. However,

^x“Ebenezer” means “stone of help”.

you shall protest solemnly to them, and shall show them the way of the king who will reign over them.” ¹⁰Samuel told all the LORD’s words to the people who asked him for a king. ¹¹He said, “This will be the way of the king who shall reign over you: he will take your sons and appoint them as his servants, for his chariots and to be his horsemen; and they will run before his chariots. ¹²He will appoint them to him for captains of thousands and captains of fifties; and he will assign some to plow his ground and to reap his harvest; and to make his instruments of war and the instruments of his chariots. ¹³He will take your daughters to be perfumers, to be cooks, and to be bakers. ¹⁴He will take your fields, your vineyards, and your olive groves, even your best, and give them to his servants. ¹⁵He will take one tenth of your seed and of your vineyards, and give it to his officers and to his servants. ¹⁶He will take your male servants, your female servants, your best young men, and your donkeys, and assign them to his own work. ¹⁷He will take one tenth of your flocks; and you will be his servants. ¹⁸You will cry out in that day because of your king whom you will have chosen for yourselves; and the LORD will not answer you in that day.” ¹⁹But the people refused to listen to the voice of Samuel; and they said, “No, but we will have a king over us, ²⁰that we also may be like all the nations; and that our king may judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles.” ²¹Samuel heard all the words of the people, and he rehearsed them in the ears of the LORD. ²²The LORD said to Samuel, “Listen to their voice, and make them a king.” Samuel said to the men of Israel, “Everyone go to your own city.”

⁹Now there was a man of Benjamin, whose name was Kish the son of Abiel, the son of Zeror, the son of Becorath, the son of Aphiah, the son of a Benjamite, a mighty man of valor. ²He had a son whose name was Saul, an impressive young man; and there was not among the children of Israel a more handsome person than he. From his shoulders and upward he was taller than any of the people. ³The donkeys of Kish, Saul’s father, were lost. Kish said to Saul his son, “Now take one of the servants with you, and arise, go look for the donkeys.” ⁴He passed through the hill country of Ephraim, and passed through the land of Shalishah, but they didn’t find them. Then they passed through the land of Shaalim, and they weren’t there. Then he passed through the land of the Benjamites, but they didn’t find them. ⁵When they had come to the land of Zuph, Saul said to his servant who was with him, “Come! Let’s return, lest my father stop caring about the donkeys and be anxious for us.” ⁶The servant said to him, “Behold now, there is a man of God in this city, and he is a man who is held in honor. All that he says surely happens. Now let’s go there. Perhaps he can tell us which way to go.” ⁷Then Saul said to his servant, “But behold, if we go, what should we bring the man? For the bread is spent in our sacks, and

there is not a present to bring to the man of God. What do we have?" ⁸The servant answered Saul again and said, "Behold, I have in my hand the fourth part of a shekel ^{xi} of silver. I will give that to the man of God, to tell us our way." ⁹(In earlier times in Israel, when a man went to inquire of God, he said, "Come! Let's go to the seer;" for he who is now called a prophet was before called a seer.) ¹⁰Then Saul said to his servant, "Well said. Come! Let's go." So they went to the city where the man of God was. ¹¹As they went up the ascent to the city, they found young maidens going out to draw water, and said to them, "Is the seer here?" ¹²They answered them and said, "He is. Behold, he is before you. Hurry now, for he has come today into the city; for the people have a sacrifice today in the high place. ¹³As soon as you have come into the city, you will immediately find him before he goes up to the high place to eat; for the people will not eat until he comes, because he blesses the sacrifice. Afterwards those who are invited eat. Now therefore go up; for at this time you will find him." ¹⁴They went up to the city. As they came within the city, behold, Samuel came out toward them to go up to the high place. ¹⁵Now the LORD had revealed to Samuel a day before Saul came, saying, ¹⁶"Tomorrow about this time I will send you a man out of the land of Benjamin, and you shall anoint him to be prince over my people Israel. He will save my people out of the hand of the Philistines; for I have looked upon my people, because their cry has come to me." ¹⁷When Samuel saw Saul, the LORD said to him, "Behold, the man of whom I spoke to you! He will have authority over my people." ¹⁸Then Saul approached Samuel in the gateway, and said, "Please tell me where the seer's house is." ¹⁹Samuel answered Saul and said, "I am the seer. Go up before me to the high place, for you are to eat with me today. In the morning I will let you go and will tell you all that is in your heart. ²⁰As for your donkeys who were lost three days ago, don't set your mind on them, for they have been found. For whom does all Israel desire? Is it not you and all your father's house?" ²¹Saul answered, "Am I not a Benjamite, of the smallest of the tribes of Israel? And my family the least of all the families of the tribe of Benjamin? Why then do you speak to me like this?" ²²Samuel took Saul and his servant and brought them into the guest room, and made them sit in the best place among those who were invited, who were about thirty persons. ²³Samuel said to the cook, "Bring the portion which I gave you, of which I said to you, 'Set it aside.'" ²⁴The cook took up the thigh, and that which was on it, and set it before Saul. Samuel said, "Behold, that which has been reserved! Set it before yourself and eat; because it has been kept for you for the appointed time, for I said, 'I have invited the people.'" So Saul ate with Samuel that day. ²⁵When they had come down from the high place

into the city, he talked with Saul on the housetop. ²⁶They arose early; and about daybreak, Samuel called to Saul on the housetop, saying, "Get up, that I may send you away." Saul arose, and they both went outside, he and Samuel, together. ²⁷As they were going down at the end of the city, Samuel said to Saul, "Tell the servant to go on ahead of us." He went ahead, then Samuel said, "But stand still first, that I may cause you to hear God's message."

¹⁰Then Samuel took the vial of oil and poured it on his head, then kissed him and said, "Hasn't the LORD anointed you to be prince over his inheritance? ²When you have departed from me today, then you will find two men by Rachel's tomb, on the border of Benjamin at Zelzah. They will tell you, 'The donkeys which you went to look for have been found; and behold, your father has stopped caring about the donkeys and is anxious for you, saying, "What shall I do for my son?"' ³"Then you will go on forward from there, and you will come to the oak of Tabor. Three men will meet you there going up to God to Bethel: one carrying three young goats, and another carrying three loaves of bread, and another carrying a container of wine. ⁴They will greet you and give you two loaves of bread, which you shall receive from their hand. ⁵"After that you will come to the hill of God, where the garri-son of the Philistines is; and it will happen, when you have come there to the city, that you will meet a band of prophets coming down from the high place with a lute, a tambourine, a pipe, and a harp before them; and they will be prophesying. ⁶Then the LORD's Spirit will come mightily on you, then you will prophesy with them and will be turned into another man. ⁷Let it be, when these signs have come to you, that you do what is appropriate for the occasion; for God is with you. ⁸"Go down ahead of me to Gilgal; and behold, I will come down to you to offer burnt offerings and to sacrifice sacrifices of peace offerings. Wait seven days, until I come to you and show you what you are to do." ⁹It was so, that when he had turned his back to go from Samuel, God gave him another heart; and all those signs happened that day. ¹⁰When they came there to the hill, behold, a band of prophets met him; and the Spirit of God came mightily on him, and he prophesied among them. ¹¹When all who knew him before saw that, behold, he prophesied with the prophets, then the people said to one another, "What is this that has come to the son of Kish? Is Saul also among the prophets?" ¹²One from the same place answered, "Who is their father?" Therefore it became a proverb, "Is Saul also among the prophets?" ¹³When he had finished prophesying, he came to the high place. ¹⁴Saul's uncle said to him and to his servant, "Where did you go?" He said, "To seek the donkeys. When we saw that they were not found, we came to Samuel." ¹⁵Saul's uncle said, "Please tell me what Samuel said to you." ¹⁶Saul said to his uncle, "He told

^{xi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1/4 shekel would be a small coin of about 2.5 grams.

us plainly that the donkeys were found.” But concerning the matter of the kingdom, of which Samuel spoke, he didn’t tell him. ¹⁷Samuel called the people together to the LORD to Mizpah; ¹⁸and he said to the children of Israel, “The LORD, the God of Israel, says ‘I brought Israel up out of Egypt and I delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all the kingdoms that oppressed you.’ ¹⁹But you have today rejected your God, who himself saves you out of all your calamities and your distresses; and you have said to him, ‘No! Set a king over us!’ Now therefore present yourselves before the LORD by your tribes and by your thousands.” ²⁰So Samuel brought all the tribes of Israel near, and the tribe of Benjamin was chosen. ²¹He brought the tribe of Benjamin near by their families and the family of the Matrites was chosen. Then Saul the son of Kish was chosen; but when they looked for him, he could not be found. ²²Therefore they asked of the LORD further, “Is there yet a man to come here?” The LORD answered, “Behold, he has hidden himself among the baggage.” ²³They ran and got him there. When he stood among the people, he was higher than any of the people from his shoulders and upward. ²⁴Samuel said to all the people, “Do you see him whom the LORD has chosen, that there is no one like him among all the people?” All the people shouted and said, “Long live the king!” ²⁵Then Samuel told the people the regulations of the kingdom, and wrote it in a book and laid it up before the LORD. Samuel sent all the people away, every man to his house. ²⁶Saul also went to his house in Gibeah; and the army went with him, whose hearts God had touched. ²⁷But certain worthless fellows said, “How could this man save us?” They despised him, and brought him no tribute. But he held his peace.

11 Then Nahash the Ammonite came up and encamped against Jabesh Gilead; and all the men of Jabesh said to Nahash, “Make a covenant with us, and we will serve you.” ²Nahash the Ammonite said to them, “On this condition I will make it with you, that all your right eyes be gouged out. I will make this dishonor all Israel.” ³The elders of Jabesh said to him, “Give us seven days, that we may send messengers to all the borders of Israel; and then, if there is no one to save us, we will come out to you.” ⁴Then the messengers came to Gibeah of Saul, and spoke these words in the ears of the people, then all the people lifted up their voice and wept. ⁵Behold, Saul came following the oxen out of the field; and Saul said, “What ails the people that they weep?” They told him the words of the men of Jabesh. ⁶God’s Spirit came mightily on Saul when he heard those words, and his anger burned hot. ⁷He took a yoke of oxen and cut them in pieces, then sent them throughout all the borders of Israel by the hand of messengers, saying, “Whoever doesn’t come out after Saul and after Samuel, so shall it be done to his oxen.” The dread of the LORD fell on the

people, and they came out as one man. ⁸He counted them in Bezek; and the children of Israel were three hundred thousand, and the men of Judah thirty thousand. ⁹They said to the messengers who came, “Tell the men of Jabesh Gilead, ‘Tomorrow, by the time the sun is hot, you will be rescued.’” The messengers came and told the men of Jabesh; and they were glad. ¹⁰Therefore the men of Jabesh said, “Tomorrow we will come out to you, and you shall do with us all that seems good to you.” ¹¹On the next day, Saul put the people in three companies; and they came into the middle of the camp in the morning watch, and struck the Ammonites until the heat of the day. Those who remained were scattered, so that no two of them were left together. ¹²The people said to Samuel, “Who is he who said, ‘Shall Saul reign over us?’ Bring those men, that we may put them to death!” ¹³Saul said, “No man shall be put to death today; for today the LORD has rescued Israel.” ¹⁴Then Samuel said to the people, “Come! Let’s go to Gilgal, and renew the kingdom there.” ¹⁵All the people went to Gilgal; and there they made Saul king before the LORD in Gilgal. There they offered sacrifices of peace offerings before the LORD; and there Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced greatly.

12 Samuel said to all Israel, “Behold, I have listened to your voice in all that you said to me, and have made a king over you. ²Now, behold, the king walks before you. I am old and gray-headed. Behold, my sons are with you. I have walked before you from my youth to this day. ³Here I am. Witness against me before the LORD and before his anointed. Whose ox have I taken? Whose donkey have I taken? Whom have I defrauded? Whom have I oppressed? Of whose hand have I taken a bribe to make me blind my eyes? I will restore it to you.” ⁴They said, “You have not defrauded us, nor oppressed us, neither have you taken anything from anyone’s hand.” ⁵He said to them, “The LORD is witness against you, and his anointed is witness today, that you have not found anything in my hand.” They said, “He is witness.” ⁶Samuel said to the people, “It is the LORD who appointed Moses and Aaron, and that brought your fathers up out of the land of Egypt. ⁷Now therefore stand still, that I may plead with you before the LORD concerning all the righteous acts of the LORD, which he did to you and to your fathers. ⁸“When Jacob had come into Egypt, and your fathers cried to the LORD, then the LORD sent Moses and Aaron, who brought your fathers out of Egypt, and made them to dwell in this place. ⁹But they forgot the LORD their God; and he sold them into the hand of Sisera, captain of the army of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab; and they fought against them. ¹⁰They cried to the LORD, and said, ‘We have sinned, because we have forsaken the LORD and have served the Baals and the Ashtaroth; but now deliver us out of the hand of our ene-

mies, and we will serve you.’ ¹¹The LORD sent Jerubbaal, Bedan, Jephthah, and Samuel, and delivered you out of the hand of your enemies on every side; and you lived in safety. ¹²“When you saw that Nahash the king of the children of Ammon came against you, you said to me, ‘No, but a king shall reign over us,’ when the LORD your God was your king. ¹³Now therefore see the king whom you have chosen and whom you have asked for. Behold, the LORD has set a king over you. ¹⁴If you will fear the LORD, and serve him, and listen to his voice, and not rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then both you and also the king who reigns over you are followers of the LORD your God. ¹⁵But if you will not listen to the LORD’s voice, but rebel against the commandment of the LORD, then the LORD’s hand will be against you, as it was against your fathers. ¹⁶“Now therefore stand still and see this great thing, which the LORD will do before your eyes. ¹⁷Isn’t it wheat harvest today? I will call to the LORD, that he may send thunder and rain; and you will know and see that your wickedness is great, which you have done in the LORD’s sight, in asking for a king.” ¹⁸So Samuel called to the LORD, and the LORD sent thunder and rain that day. Then all the people greatly feared the LORD and Samuel. ¹⁹All the people said to Samuel, “Pray for your servants to the LORD your God, that we not die; for we have added to all our sins this evil, to ask for a king.” ²⁰Samuel said to the people, “Don’t be afraid. You have indeed done all this evil; yet don’t turn away from following the LORD, but serve the LORD with all your heart. ²¹Don’t turn away to go after vain things which can’t profit or deliver, for they are vain. ²²For the LORD will not forsake his people for his great name’s sake, because it has pleased the LORD to make you a people for himself. ²³Moreover, as for me, far be it from me that I should sin against the LORD in ceasing to pray for you; but I will instruct you in the good and the right way. ²⁴Only fear the LORD, and serve him in truth with all your heart; for consider what great things he has done for you. ²⁵But if you keep doing evil, you will be consumed, both you and your king.”

13 Saul was thirty years old when he became king, and he reigned over Israel forty-two years. ^{xii} ²Saul chose for himself three thousand men of Israel, of which two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in the Mount of Bethel, and one thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin. He sent the rest of the people to their own tents. ³Jonathan struck the garrison of the Philistines that was in Geba, and the Philistines heard of it. Saul blew the shofar throughout all the land, saying, “Let the Hebrews hear!” ⁴All Israel heard that Saul had struck the garrison of the Philistines, and also that Israel was considered an abomination to the Philistines. The people were

gathered together after Saul to Gilgal. ⁵The Philistines assembled themselves together to fight with Israel: thirty thousand chariots, six thousand horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the seashore in multitude. They came up and encamped in Michmash, eastward of Beth Aven. ⁶When the men of Israel saw that they were in trouble (for the people were distressed), then the people hid themselves in caves, in thickets, in rocks, in tombs, and in pits. ⁷Now some of the Hebrews had gone over the Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead; but as for Saul, he was yet in Gilgal, and all the people followed him trembling. ⁸He stayed seven days, according to the time set by Samuel; but Samuel didn’t come to Gilgal, and the people were scattering from him. ⁹Saul said, “Bring the burnt offering to me here, and the peace offerings.” He offered the burnt offering. ¹⁰It came to pass that as soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, behold, Samuel came; and Saul went out to meet him, that he might greet him. ¹¹Samuel said, “What have you done?” Saul said, “Because I saw that the people were scattered from me, and that you didn’t come within the days appointed, and that the Philistines assembled themselves together at Michmash, ¹²therefore I said, ‘Now the Philistines will come down on me to Gilgal, and I haven’t entreated the favor of the LORD.’ I forced myself therefore, and offered the burnt offering.” ¹³Samuel said to Saul, “You have done foolishly. You have not kept the commandment of the LORD your God, which he commanded you; for now the LORD would have established your kingdom on Israel forever. ¹⁴But now your kingdom will not continue. The LORD has sought for himself a man after his own heart, and the LORD has appointed him to be prince over his people, because you have not kept that which the LORD commanded you.” ¹⁵Samuel arose, and went from Gilgal to Gibeah of Benjamin. Saul counted the people who were present with him, about six hundred men. ¹⁶Saul, and Jonathan his son, and the people who were present with them, stayed in Geba of Benjamin; but the Philistines encamped in Michmash. ¹⁷The raiders came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies: one company turned to the way that leads to Ophrah, to the land of Shual; ¹⁸another company turned the way to Beth Horon; and another company turned the way of the border that looks down on the valley of Zeboim toward the wilderness. ¹⁹Now there was no blacksmith found throughout all Eretz-Israel, for the Philistines said, “Lest the Hebrews make themselves swords or spears”; ²⁰but all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, each man to sharpen his own plowshare, mattock, ax, and sickle. ²¹The price was one payim ^{xiii} each to sharpen mattocks, plowshares, pitchforks, axes, and goads. ²²So it came to pass in the day of battle that neither sword nor spear was found in the hand of any of the people who were with Saul and Jonathan;

^{xii}The traditional Hebrew text omits “thirty” and “forty-”. The blanks are filled in here from a few manuscripts of the Septuagint.

^{xiii}A payim (or pim) was 2/3 shekel of silver, or 0.26 ounces, or 7.6 grams

but Saul and Jonathan his son had them. ²³The garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash.

¹⁴Now it happened on a day that Jonathan the son of Saul said to the young man who bore his armor, "Come! Let's go over to the Philistines' garrison that is on the other side." But he didn't tell his father. ²Saul stayed in the uttermost part of Gibeah under the pomegranate tree which is in Migron; and the people who were with him were about six hundred men, ³including Ahijah the son of Ahitub, Ichabod's brother, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli the priest of the LORD in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. The people didn't know that Jonathan was gone. ⁴Between the passes, by which Jonathan sought to go over to the Philistines' garrison, there was a rocky crag on the one side and a rocky crag on the other side; and the name of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh. ⁵The one crag rose up on the north in front of Michmash, and the other on the south in front of Geba. ⁶Jonathan said to the young man who bore his armor, "Come! Let's go over to the garrison of these uncircumcised. It may be that the LORD will work for us, for there is no restraint on the LORD to save by many or by few." ⁷His armor bearer said to him, "Do all that is in your heart. Go, and behold, I am with you according to your heart." ⁸Then Jonathan said, "Behold, we will pass over to the men, and we will reveal ourselves to them. ⁹If they say this to us, 'Wait until we come to you!' then we will stand still in our place and will not go up to them. ¹⁰But if they say this, 'Come up to us!' then we will go up, for the LORD has delivered them into our hand. This shall be the sign to us." ¹¹Both of them revealed themselves to the garrison of the Philistines; and the Philistines said, "Behold, the Hebrews are coming out of the holes where they had hidden themselves!" ¹²The men of the garrison answered Jonathan and his armor bearer, and said, "Come up to us, and we will show you something!" Jonathan said to his armor bearer, "Come up after me, for the LORD has delivered them into the hand of Israel." ¹³Jonathan climbed up on his hands and on his feet, and his armor bearer after him, and they fell before Jonathan; and his armor bearer killed them after him. ¹⁴That first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armor bearer made, was about twenty men, within as it were half a furrow's length in an acre of land. ¹⁵There was a trembling in the camp, in the field, and among all the people; the garrison and the raiders also trembled; and the earth quaked, so there was an exceedingly great trembling. ¹⁶The watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked; and behold, the multitude melted away and scattered. ¹⁷Then Saul said to the people who were with him, "Count now, and see who is missing from us." When they had counted, behold, Jonathan and his armor bearer were not there. ¹⁸Saul said to Ahijah, "Bring God's ark here." For God's ark was with the children of Israel at that time.

¹⁹While Saul talked to the priest, the tumult that was in the camp of the Philistines went on and increased; and Saul said to the priest, "Withdraw your hand!" ²⁰Saul and all the people who were with him were gathered together, and came to the battle; and behold, they were all striking each other with their swords in very great confusion. ²¹Now the Hebrews who were with the Philistines before and who went up with them into the camp from all around, even they also turned to be with the Israelites who were with Saul and Jonathan. ²²Likewise all the men of Israel who had hidden themselves in the hill country of Ephraim, when they heard that the Philistines fled, even they also followed hard after them in the battle. ²³So the LORD saved Israel that day; and the battle passed over by Beth Aven. ²⁴The men of Israel were distressed that day; for Saul had adjured the people, saying, "Cursed is the man who eats any food until it is evening, and I am avenged of my enemies." So none of the people tasted food. ²⁵All the people came into the forest; and there was honey on the ground. ²⁶When the people had come to the forest, behold, honey was dripping, but no one put his hand to his mouth, for the people feared the oath. ²⁷But Jonathan didn't hear when his father commanded the people with the oath. Therefore he put out the end of the rod that was in his hand and dipped it in the honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes brightened. ²⁸Then one of the people answered, and said, "Your father directly commanded the people with an oath, saying, 'Cursed is the man who eats food today.'" So the people were faint. ²⁹Then Jonathan said, "My father has troubled the land. Please look how my eyes have brightened because I tasted a little of this honey. ³⁰How much more, if perhaps the people had eaten freely today of the plunder of their enemies which they found? For now there has been no great slaughter among the Philistines." ³¹They struck the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon. The people were very faint; ³²and the people pounced on the plunder, and took sheep, cattle, and calves, and killed them on the ground; and the people ate them with the blood. ³³Then they told Saul, saying, "Behold, the people are sinning against the LORD, in that they eat meat with the blood." He said, "You have dealt treacherously. Roll a large stone to me today!" ³⁴Saul said, "Disperse yourselves among the people, and tell them, 'Every man bring me here his ox, and every man his sheep, and kill them here, and eat; and don't sin against the LORD in eating meat with the blood.'" All the people brought every man his ox with him that night, and killed them there. ³⁵Saul built an altar to the LORD. This was the first altar that he built to the LORD. ³⁶Saul said, "Let's go down after the Philistines by night, and take plunder among them until the morning light. Let's not leave a man of them." They said, "Do whatever seems good to you." Then the priest said, "Let's draw near here to God." ³⁷Saul asked counsel of God: "Shall I go down

after the Philistines? Will you deliver them into the hand of Israel?" But he didn't answer him that day. ³⁸Saul said, "Draw near here, all you chiefs of the people, and know and see in whom this sin has been today. ³⁹For as the LORD lives, who saves Israel, though it is in Jonathan my son, he shall surely die." But there was not a man among all the people who answered him. ⁴⁰Then he said to all Israel, "You be on one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side." The people said to Saul, "Do what seems good to you." ⁴¹Therefore Saul said to the LORD, the God of Israel, "Show the right." Jonathan and Saul were chosen, but the people escaped. ⁴²Saul said, "Cast lots between me and Jonathan my son." Jonathan was selected. ⁴³Then Saul said to Jonathan, "Tell me what you have done!" Jonathan told him, and said, "I certainly did taste a little honey with the end of the rod that was in my hand; and behold, I must die." ⁴⁴Saul said, "God do so and more also; for you shall surely die, Jonathan." ⁴⁵The people said to Saul, "Shall Jonathan die, who has worked this great salvation in Israel? Far from it! As the LORD lives, there shall not one hair of his head fall to the ground, for he has worked with God today!" So the people rescued Jonathan, so he didn't die. ⁴⁶Then Saul went up from following the Philistines; and the Philistines went to their own place. ⁴⁷Now when Saul had taken the kingdom over Israel, he fought against all his enemies on every side: against Moab, and against the children of Ammon, and against Edom, and against the kings of Zobah, and against the Philistines. Wherever he turned himself, he defeated them. ⁴⁸He did valiantly and struck the Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the hands of those who plundered them. ⁴⁹Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan, Ishvi, and Malchishua; and the names of his two daughters were these: the name of the firstborn Merab, and the name of the younger Michal. ⁵⁰The name of Saul's wife was Ahinoam the daughter of Ahimaaz. The name of the captain of his army was Abner the son of Ner, Saul's uncle. ⁵¹Kish was the father of Saul, and Ner the father of Abner was the son of Abiel. ⁵²There was severe war against the Philistines all the days of Saul; and when Saul saw any mighty man or any valiant man, he took him into his service.

15Samuel said to Saul, "The LORD sent me to anoint you to be king over his people, over Israel. Now therefore listen to the voice of the LORD's words. ²The LORD of Hosts says, 'I remember what Amalek did to Israel, how he set himself against him on the way when he came up out of Egypt. ³Now go and strike Amalek, and utterly destroy all that they have, and don't spare them; but kill both man and woman, infant and nursing baby, ox and sheep, camel and donkey.'" ⁴Saul summoned the people, and counted them in Telaim, two hundred thousand footmen and ten thousand men of Judah. ⁵Saul came to the city of Amalek, and set an ambush in the valley. ⁶Saul

said to the Kenites, "Go, depart, go down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them; for you showed kindness to all the children of Israel when they came up out of Egypt." So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites. ⁷Saul struck the Amalekites, from Havilah as you go to Shur, which is before Egypt. ⁸He took Agag the king of the Amalekites alive, and utterly destroyed all the people with the edge of the sword. ⁹But Saul and the people spared Agag and the best of the sheep, of the cattle, of the fat calves, of the lambs, and all that was good, and were not willing to utterly destroy them; but everything that was vile and refuse, that they destroyed utterly. ¹⁰Then the LORD's word came to Samuel, saying, ¹¹"It grieves me that I have set up Saul to be king, for he has turned back from following me, and has not performed my commandments." Samuel was angry; and he cried to the LORD all night. ¹²Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the morning; and Samuel was told, saying, "Saul came to Carmel, and behold, he set up a monument for himself, turned, passed on, and went down to Gilgal." ¹³Samuel came to Saul; and Saul said to him, "You are blessed by the LORD! I have performed the commandment of the LORD." ¹⁴Samuel said, "Then what does this bleating of the sheep in my ears and the lowing of the cattle which I hear mean?" ¹⁵Saul said, "They have brought them from the Amalekites; for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the cattle, to sacrifice to the LORD your God. We have utterly destroyed the rest." ¹⁶Then Samuel said to Saul, "Stay, and I will tell you what the LORD said to me last night." He said to him, "Say on." ¹⁷Samuel said, "Though you were little in your own sight, weren't you made the head of the tribes of Israel? The LORD anointed you king over Israel; ¹⁸and the LORD sent you on a journey, and said, 'Go, and utterly destroy the sinners the Amalekites, and fight against them until they are consumed.' ¹⁹Why then didn't you obey the LORD's voice, but took the plunder, and did that which was evil in the LORD's sight?" ²⁰Saul said to Samuel, "But I have obeyed the LORD's voice, and have gone the way which the LORD sent me, and have brought Agag the king of Amalek, and have utterly destroyed the Amalekites. ²¹But the people took of the plunder, sheep and cattle, the best of the devoted things, to sacrifice to the LORD your God in Gilgal." ²²Samuel said, "Has the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the LORD's voice? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen than the fat of rams. ²³For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and stubbornness is as idolatry and teraphim. ^{xiv} Because you have rejected the LORD's word, he has also rejected you from being king." ²⁴Saul said to Samuel, "I have sinned; for I have transgressed the commandment of the LORD and your words, because I feared the people

^{xiv}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

and obeyed their voice. ²⁵Now therefore, please pardon my sin, and turn again with me, that I may worship the LORD.” ²⁶Samuel said to Saul, “I will not return with you; for you have rejected the LORD’s word, and the LORD has rejected you from being king over Israel.” ²⁷As Samuel turned around to go away, Saul grabbed the skirt of his robe, and it tore. ²⁸Samuel said to him, “The LORD has torn the kingdom of Israel from you today, and has given it to a neighbor of yours who is better than you. ²⁹Also the Strength of Israel will not lie nor repent; for he is not a man, that he should repent.” ³⁰Then he said, “I have sinned; yet please honor me now before the elders of my people and before Israel, and come back with me, that I may worship the LORD your God.” ³¹So Samuel went back with Saul; and Saul worshiped the LORD. ³²Then Samuel said, “Bring Agag the king of the Amalekites here to me!” Agag came to him cheerfully. Agag said, “Surely the bitterness of death is past.” ³³Samuel said, “As your sword has made women childless, so your mother will be childless among women!” Then Samuel cut Agag in pieces before the LORD in Gilgal. ³⁴Then Samuel went to Ramah; and Saul went up to his house to Gibeah of Saul. ³⁵Samuel came no more to see Saul until the day of his death, but Samuel mourned for Saul. The LORD grieved that he had made Saul king over Israel.

16 The LORD said to Samuel, “How long will you mourn for Saul, since I have rejected him from being king over Israel? Fill your horn with oil, and go. I will send you to Jesse the Bethlehemite, for I have provided a king for myself among his sons.” ²Samuel said, “How can I go? If Saul hears it, he will kill me.” The LORD said, “Take a heifer with you, and say, ‘I have come to sacrifice to the LORD.’ ³Call Jesse to the sacrifice, and I will show you what you shall do. You shall anoint to me him whom I name to you.” ⁴Samuel did that which the LORD spoke, and came to Bethlehem. The elders of the city came to meet him trembling, and said, “Do you come peaceably?” ⁵He said, “Peaceably; I have come to sacrifice to the LORD. Sanctify yourselves, and come with me to the sacrifice.” He sanctified Jesse and his sons, and called them to the sacrifice. ⁶When they had come, he looked at Eliab, and said, “Surely the LORD’s anointed is before him.” ⁷But the LORD said to Samuel, “Don’t look on his face, or on the height of his stature, because I have rejected him; for I don’t see as man sees. For man looks at the outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart.” ⁸Then Jesse called Abinadab, and made him pass before Samuel. He said, “The LORD has not chosen this one, either.” ⁹Then Jesse made Shammah to pass by. He said, “The LORD has not chosen this one, either.” ¹⁰Jesse made seven of his sons to pass before Samuel. Samuel said to Jesse, “The LORD has not chosen these.” ¹¹Samuel said to Jesse, “Are all your children here?” He said, “There remains yet the

youngest. Behold, he is keeping the sheep.” Samuel said to Jesse, “Send and get him, for we will not sit down until he comes here.” ¹²He sent, and brought him in. Now he was ruddy, with a handsome face and good appearance. The LORD said, “Arise! Anoint him, for this is he.” ¹³Then Samuel took the horn of oil and anointed him in the middle of his brothers. Then the LORD’s Spirit came mightily on David from that day forward. So Samuel rose up and went to Ramah. ¹⁴Now the LORD’s Spirit departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the LORD troubled him. ¹⁵Saul’s servants said to him, “See now, an evil spirit from God troubles you. ¹⁶Let our lord now command your servants who are in front of you to seek out a man who is a skillful player on the harp. Then when the evil spirit from God is on you, he will play with his hand, and you will be well.” ¹⁷Saul said to his servants, “Provide me now a man who can play well, and bring him to me.” ¹⁸Then one of the young men answered and said, “Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite who is skillful in playing, a mighty man of valor, a man of war, prudent in speech, and a handsome person; and the LORD is with him.” ¹⁹Therefore Saul sent messengers to Jesse, and said, “Send me David your son, who is with the sheep.” ²⁰Jesse took a donkey loaded with bread, a container of wine, and a young goat, and sent them by David his son to Saul. ²¹David came to Saul and stood before him. He loved him greatly; and he became his armor bearer. ²²Saul sent to Jesse, saying, “Please let David stand before me, for he has found favor in my sight.” ²³When the spirit from God was on Saul, David took the harp and played with his hand; so Saul was refreshed and was well, and the evil spirit departed from him.

17 Now the Philistines gathered together their armies to battle; and they were gathered together at Socoh, which belongs to Judah, and encamped between Socoh and Azekah in Ephesdammin. ²Saul and the men of Israel were gathered together, and encamped in the valley of Elah, and set the battle in array against the Philistines. ³The Philistines stood on the mountain on the one side, and Israel stood on the mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them. ⁴A champion out of the camp of the Philistines named Goliath of Gath, whose height was six cubits and a span ^{xv} went out. ⁵He had a helmet of bronze on his head, and he wore a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels ^{xvi} of bronze. ⁶He had bronze shin armor on his legs and a bronze javelin between

^{xv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A span is the length from the tip of a man’s thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.) Therefore, Goliath was about 9 feet and 9 inches or 2.97 meters tall.

^{xvi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 5000 shekels is about 50 kilograms or 110 pounds.

his shoulders. ⁷The staff of his spear was like a weaver's beam; and his spear's head weighed six hundred shekels of iron. ^{xvii} His shield bearer went before him. ⁸He stood and cried to the armies of Israel, and said to them, "Why have you come out to set your battle in array? Am I not a Philistine, and you servants to Saul? Choose a man for yourselves, and let him come down to me. ⁹If he is able to fight with me and kill me, then will we be your servants; but if I prevail against him and kill him, then you will be our servants and serve us." ¹⁰The Philistine said, "I defy the armies of Israel today! Give me a man, that we may fight together!" ¹¹When Saul and all Israel heard those words of the Philistine, they were dismayed and greatly afraid. ¹²Now David was the son of that Ephrathite of Bethlehem Judah, whose name was Jesse; and he had eight sons. The man was an elderly old man in the days of Saul. ¹³The three oldest sons of Jesse had gone after Saul to the battle; and the names of his three sons who went to the battle were Eliab the firstborn, and next to him Abinadab, and the third Shammah. ¹⁴David was the youngest; and the three oldest followed Saul. ¹⁵Now David went back and forth from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem. ¹⁶The Philistine came near morning and evening, and presented himself forty days. ¹⁷Jesse said to David his son, "Now take for your brothers an ephah ^{xviii} of this parched grain and these ten loaves, and carry them quickly to the camp to your brothers; ¹⁸and bring these ten cheeses to the captain of their thousand; and see how your brothers are doing, and bring back news." ¹⁹Now Saul, and they, and all the men of Israel were in the valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines. ²⁰David rose up early in the morning and left the sheep with a keeper, and took the provisions and went, as Jesse had commanded him. He came to the place of the wagons as the army which was going out to the fight shouted for the battle. ²¹Israel and the Philistines put the battle in array, army against army. ²²David left his baggage in the hand of the keeper of the baggage and ran to the army, and came and greeted his brothers. ²³As he talked with them, behold, the champion, the Philistine of Gath, Goliath by name, came up out of the ranks of the Philistines, and said the same words; and David heard them. ²⁴All the men of Israel, when they saw the man, fled from him and were terrified. ²⁵The men of Israel said, "Have you seen this man who has come up? He has surely come up to defy Israel. The king will give great riches to the man who kills him, and will give him his daughter, and will make his father's house tax-free in Israel." ²⁶David spoke to the men who stood by him, saying, "What shall be done to the man who kills this Philistine and takes away the reproach from Israel? For who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies

of the living God?" ²⁷The people answered him in this way, saying, "So shall it be done to the man who kills him." ²⁸Eliab his oldest brother heard when he spoke to the men; and Eliab's anger burned against David, and he said, "Why have you come down? With whom have you left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know your pride and the evil of your heart; for you have come down that you might see the battle." ²⁹David said, "What have I now done? Is there not a cause?" ³⁰He turned away from him toward another, and spoke like that again; and the people answered him again the same way. ³¹When the words were heard which David spoke, they rehearsed them before Saul; and he sent for him. ³²David said to Saul, "Let no man's heart fail because of him. Your servant will go and fight with this Philistine." ³³Saul said to David, "You are not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him; for you are but a youth, and he a man of war from his youth." ³⁴David said to Saul, "Your servant was keeping his father's sheep; and when a lion or a bear came and took a lamb out of the flock, ³⁵I went out after him, struck him, and rescued it out of his mouth. When he arose against me, I caught him by his beard, struck him, and killed him. ³⁶Your servant struck both the lion and the bear. This uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, since he has defied the armies of the living God." ³⁷David said, "The LORD, who delivered me out of the paw of the lion and out of the paw of the bear, will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine." Saul said to David, "Go! The LORD will be with you." ³⁸Saul dressed David with his clothing. He put a helmet of bronze on his head, and he clad him with a coat of mail. ³⁹David strapped his sword on his clothing and he tried to move, for he had not tested it. David said to Saul, "I can't go with these, for I have not tested them." Then David took them off. ⁴⁰He took his staff in his hand, and chose for himself five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them in the pouch of his shepherd's bag which he had. His sling was in his hand; and he came near to the Philistine. ⁴¹The Philistine walked and came near to David; and the man who bore the shield went before him. ⁴²When the Philistine looked around and saw David, he disdained him; for he was but a youth, and ruddy, and had a good looking face. ⁴³The Philistine said to David, "Am I a dog, that you come to me with sticks?" The Philistine cursed David by his gods. ⁴⁴The Philistine said to David, "Come to me, and I will give your flesh to the birds of the sky and to the animals of the field." ⁴⁵Then David said to the Philistine, "You come to me with a sword, with a spear, and with a javelin; but I come to you in the name of the LORD of Hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom you have defied. ⁴⁶Today, the LORD will deliver you into my hand. I will strike you and take your head from off you. I will give the dead bodies of the army of the Philistines today to the birds of the sky and to the wild animals of the earth, that all the earth may know that there is a God

^{xvii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 600 shekels is about 6 kilograms or about 13 pounds.

^{xviii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

in Israel, ⁴⁷and that all this assembly may know that the LORD doesn't save with sword and spear; for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hand." ⁴⁸When the Philistine arose, and walked and came near to meet David, David hurried and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine. ⁴⁹David put his hand in his bag, took a stone and slung it, and struck the Philistine in his forehead. The stone sank into his forehead, and he fell on his face to the earth. ⁵⁰So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and struck the Philistine and killed him; but there was no sword in David's hand. ⁵¹Then David ran, stood over the Philistine, took his sword, drew it out of its sheath, killed him, and cut off his head with it. When the Philistines saw that their champion was dead, they fled. ⁵²The men of Israel and of Judah arose and shouted, and pursued the Philistines as far as Gai and to the gates of Ekron. The wounded of the Philistines fell down by the way to Shaaraim, even to Gath and to Ekron. ⁵³The children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines, and they plundered their camp. ⁵⁴David took the head of the Philistine and brought it to Jerusalem, but he put his armor in his tent. ⁵⁵When Saul saw David go out against the Philistine, he said to Abner, the captain of the army, "Abner, whose son is this youth?" Abner said, "As your soul lives, O king, I can't tell." ⁵⁶The king said, "Inquire whose son the young man is!" ⁵⁷As David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, Abner took him and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand. ⁵⁸Saul said to him, "Whose son are you, you young man?" David answered, "I am the son of your servant Jesse the Bethlehemite."

18When he had finished speaking to Saul, the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul. ²Saul took him that day, and wouldn't let him go home to his father's house any more. ³Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul. ⁴Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was on him and gave it to David with his clothing, even including his sword, his bow, and his sash. ⁵David went out wherever Saul sent him, and behaved himself wisely; and Saul set him over the men of war. It was good in the sight of all the people, and also in the sight of Saul's servants. ⁶As they came, when David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, the women came out of all the cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet King Saul with tambourines, with joy, and with instruments of music. ⁷The women sang to one another as they played, and said, "Saul has slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands." ⁸Saul was very angry, and this saying displeased him. He said, "They have credited David with ten thousands, and they have only credited me with thousands. What can he have more but the kingdom?" ⁹Saul watched David from that day and forward. ¹⁰On the next

day, an evil spirit from God came mightily on Saul, and he prophesied in the middle of the house. David played with his hand, as he did day by day. Saul had his spear in his hand; ¹¹and Saul threw the spear, for he said, "I will pin David to the wall!" David escaped from his presence twice. ¹²Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with him, and had departed from Saul. ¹³Therefore Saul removed him from his presence, and made him his captain over a thousand; and he went out and came in before the people. ¹⁴David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and the LORD was with him. ¹⁵When Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, he stood in awe of him. ¹⁶But all Israel and Judah loved David; for he went out and came in before them. ¹⁷Saul said to David, "Behold, my elder daughter Merab. I will give her to you as wife. Only be valiant for me, and fight the LORD's battles." For Saul said, "Don't let my hand be on him, but let the hand of the Philistines be on him." ¹⁸David said to Saul, "Who am I, and what is my life, or my father's family in Israel, that I should be son-in-law to the king?" ¹⁹But at the time when Merab, Saul's daughter, should have been given to David, she was given to Adriel the Meholahite as wife. ²⁰Michal, Saul's daughter, loved David; and they told Saul, and the thing pleased him. ²¹Saul said, I will give her to him, that she may be a snare to him and that the hand of the Philistines may be against him. Therefore Saul said to David a second time, "You shall today be my son-in-law." ²²Saul commanded his servants, "Talk with David secretly, and say, 'Behold, the king has delight in you, and all his servants love you. Now therefore be the king's son-in-law.'" ²³Saul's servants spoke those words in the ears of David. David said, "Does it seem to you a light thing to be the king's son-in-law, since I am a poor man and little known?" ²⁴The servants of Saul told him, saying, "David spoke like this." ²⁵Saul said, "Tell David, 'The king desires no dowry except one hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be avenged of the king's enemies.'" Now Saul thought he would make David fall by the hand of the Philistines. ²⁶When his servants told David these words, it pleased David well to be the king's son-in-law. Before the deadline, ²⁷David arose and went, he and his men, and killed two hundred men of the Philistines. Then David brought their foreskins, and they gave them in full number to the king, that he might be the king's son-in-law. Then Saul gave him Michal his daughter as wife. ²⁸Saul saw and knew that the LORD was with David; and Michal, Saul's daughter, loved him. ²⁹Saul was even more afraid of David; and Saul was David's enemy continually. ³⁰Then the princes of the Philistines went out; and as often as they went out, David behaved himself more wisely than all the servants of Saul, so that his name was highly esteemed.

19Saul spoke to Jonathan his son and to all his servants, that they should kill David. But Jonathan, Saul's

son, greatly delighted in David. ²Jonathan told David, saying, "Saul my father seeks to kill you. Now therefore, please take care of yourself in the morning, live in a secret place, and hide yourself. ³I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where you are, and I will talk with my father about you; and if I see anything, I will tell you." ⁴Jonathan spoke good of David to Saul his father, and said to him, "Don't let the king sin against his servant, against David; because he has not sinned against you, and because his works have been very good toward you; ⁵for he put his life in his hand and struck the Philistine, and the LORD worked a great victory for all Israel. You saw it and rejoiced. Why then will you sin against innocent blood, to kill David without a cause?" ⁶Saul listened to the voice of Jonathan; and Saul swore, "As the LORD lives, he shall not be put to death." ⁷Jonathan called David, and Jonathan showed him all those things. Then Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was in his presence as before. ⁸There was war again. David went out and fought with the Philistines, and killed them with a great slaughter; and they fled before him. ⁹An evil spirit from the LORD was on Saul as he sat in his house with his spear in his hand; and David was playing music with his hand. ¹⁰Saul sought to pin David to the wall with the spear, but he slipped away out of Saul's presence; and he stuck the spear into the wall. David fled and escaped that night. ¹¹Saul sent messengers to David's house to watch him and to kill him in the morning. Michal, David's wife, told him, saying, "If you don't save your life tonight, tomorrow you will be killed." ¹²So Michal let David down through the window. He went away, fled, and escaped. ¹³Michal took the teraphim ^{xix} and laid it in the bed, and put a pillow of goats' hair at its head and covered it with clothes. ¹⁴When Saul sent messengers to take David, she said, "He is sick." ¹⁵Saul sent the messengers to see David, saying, "Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may kill him." ¹⁶When the messengers came in, behold, the teraphim was in the bed, with the pillow of goats' hair at its head. ¹⁷Saul said to Michal, "Why have you deceived me like this and let my enemy go, so that he has escaped?" Michal answered Saul, "He said to me, 'Let me go! Why should I kill you?'" ¹⁸Now David fled and escaped, and came to Samuel at Ramah, and told him all that Saul had done to him. He and Samuel went and lived in Naioth. ¹⁹Saul was told, saying, "Behold, David is at Naioth in Ramah." ²⁰Saul sent messengers to seize David; and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as head over them, God's Spirit came on Saul's messengers, and they also prophesied. ²¹When Saul was told, he sent other messengers, and they also prophesied. Saul sent messengers again the third time, and they also prophesied. ²²Then he also went to Ramah, and came to the great

well that is in Secu: and he asked, "Where are Samuel and David?" One said, "Behold, they are at Naioth in Ramah." ²³He went there to Naioth in Ramah. Then God's Spirit came on him also, and he went on, and prophesied, until he came to Naioth in Ramah. ²⁴He also stripped off his clothes. He also prophesied before Samuel and lay down naked all that day and all that night. Therefore they say, "Is Saul also among the prophets?"

20David fled from Naioth in Ramah, and came and said to Jonathan, "What have I done? What is my iniquity? What is my sin before your father, that he seeks my life?" ²He said to him, "Far from it; you will not die. Behold, my father does nothing either great or small, but that he discloses it to me. Why would my father hide this thing from me? It is not so." ³David swore moreover, and said, "Your father knows well that I have found favor in your eyes; and he says, 'Don't let Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved;' but truly as the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, there is but a step between me and death." ⁴Then Jonathan said to David, "Whatever your soul desires, I will even do it for you." ⁵David said to Jonathan, "Behold, tomorrow is the new moon, and I should not fail to dine with the king; but let me go, that I may hide myself in the field to the third day at evening. ⁶If your father misses me at all, then say, 'David earnestly asked leave of me that he might run to Bethlehem, his city; for it is the yearly sacrifice there for all the family.' ⁷If he says, 'It is well,' your servant shall have peace; but if he is angry, then know that evil is determined by him. ⁸Therefore deal kindly with your servant, for you have brought your servant into a covenant of the LORD with you; but if there is iniquity in me, kill me yourself, for why should you bring me to your father?" ⁹Jonathan said, "Far be it from you; for if I should at all know that evil were determined by my father to come on you, then wouldn't I tell you that?" ¹⁰Then David said to Jonathan, "Who will tell me if your father answers you roughly?" ¹¹Jonathan said to David, "Come! Let's go out into the field." They both went out into the field. ¹²Jonathan said to David, "By the LORD, the God of Israel, when I have sounded out my father about this time tomorrow, or the third day, behold, if there is good toward David, won't I then send to you and disclose it to you? ¹³The LORD do so to Jonathan and more also, should it please my father to do you evil, if I don't disclose it to you and send you away, that you may go in peace. May the LORD be with you as he has been with my father. ¹⁴You shall not only show me the loving kindness of the LORD while I still live, that I not die; ¹⁵but you shall also not cut off your kindness from my house forever, no, not when the LORD has cut off every one of the enemies of David from the surface of the earth." ¹⁶So Jonathan made a covenant with David's house, saying, "The LORD will require it at the hand of David's enemies." ¹⁷Jonathan caused David to swear again, for

^{xix}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

the love that he had to him; for he loved him as he loved his own soul. ¹⁸Then Jonathan said to him, "Tomorrow is the new moon, and you will be missed, because your seat will be empty. ¹⁹When you have stayed three days, go down quickly and come to the place where you hid yourself when this started, and remain by the stone Ezel. ²⁰I will shoot three arrows on its side, as though I shot at a mark. ²¹Behold, I will send the boy, saying, 'Go, find the arrows!' If I tell the boy, 'Behold, the arrows are on this side of you. Take them;' then come, for there is peace to you and no danger, as the LORD lives. ²²But if I say this to the boy, 'Behold, the arrows are beyond you,' then go your way, for the LORD has sent you away. ²³Concerning the matter which you and I have spoken of, behold, the LORD is between you and me forever." ²⁴So David hid himself in the field. When the new moon had come, the king sat himself down to eat food. ²⁵The king sat on his seat, as at other times, even on the seat by the wall; and Jonathan stood up, and Abner sat by Saul's side, but David's place was empty. ²⁶Nevertheless Saul didn't say anything that day, for he thought, "Something has happened to him. He is not clean. Surely he is not clean." ²⁷On the next day after the new moon, the second day, David's place was empty. Saul said to Jonathan his son, "Why didn't the son of Jesse come to eat, either yesterday, or today?" ²⁸Jonathan answered Saul, "David earnestly asked permission of me to go to Bethlehem. ²⁹He said, 'Please let me go, for our family has a sacrifice in the city. My brother has commanded me to be there. Now, if I have found favor in your eyes, please let me go away and see my brothers.' Therefore he has not come to the king's table." ³⁰Then Saul's anger burned against Jonathan, and he said to him, "You son of a perverse rebellious woman, don't I know that you have chosen the son of Jesse to your own shame, and to the shame of your mother's nakedness? ³¹For as long as the son of Jesse lives on the earth, you will not be established, nor will your kingdom. Therefore now send and bring him to me, for he shall surely die!" ³²Jonathan answered Saul his father, and said to him, "Why should he be put to death? What has he done?" ³³Saul cast his spear at him to strike him. By this Jonathan knew that his father was determined to put David to death. ³⁴So Jonathan arose from the table in fierce anger, and ate no food the second day of the month; for he was grieved for David, because his father had treated him shamefully. ³⁵In the morning, Jonathan went out into the field at the time appointed with David, and a little boy with him. ³⁶He said to his boy, "Run, find now the arrows which I shoot." As the boy ran, he shot an arrow beyond him. ³⁷When the boy had come to the place of the arrow which Jonathan had shot, Jonathan cried after the boy, and said, "Isn't the arrow beyond you?" ³⁸Jonathan cried after the boy, "Go fast! Hurry! Don't delay!" Jonathan's boy gathered up the arrows, and came to his master. ³⁹But the boy didn't

know anything. Only Jonathan and David knew the matter. ⁴⁰Jonathan gave his weapons to his boy, and said to him, "Go, carry them to the city." ⁴¹As soon as the boy was gone, David arose out of the south, and fell on his face to the ground, and bowed himself three times. They kissed one another and wept with one another, and David wept the most. ⁴²Jonathan said to David, "Go in peace, because we have both sworn in the LORD's name, saying, 'The LORD is between me and you, and between my offspring and your offspring, forever.'" He arose and departed; and Jonathan went into the city.

21 Then David came to Nob to Ahimelech the priest. Ahimelech came to meet David trembling, and said to him, "Why are you alone, and no man with you?" ²David said to Ahimelech the priest, "The king has commanded me to do something, and has said to me, 'Let no one know anything about the business about which I send you, and what I have commanded you. I have sent the young men to a certain place.' ³Now therefore what is under your hand? Please give me five loaves of bread in my hand, or whatever is available." ⁴The priest answered David, and said, "I have no common bread, but there is holy bread; if only the young men have kept themselves from women." ⁵David answered the priest, and said to him, "Truly, women have been kept from us as usual these three days. When I came out, the vessels of the young men were holy, though it was only a common journey. How much more then today shall their vessels be holy?" ⁶So the priest gave him holy bread; for there was no bread there but the show bread that was taken from before the LORD, to be replaced with hot bread in the day when it was taken away. ⁷Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, detained before the LORD; and his name was Doeg the Edomite, the best of the herdsmen who belonged to Saul. ⁸David said to Ahimelech, "Isn't there here under your hand spear or sword? For I haven't brought my sword or my weapons with me, because the king's business required haste." ⁹The priest said, "Behold, the sword of Goliath the Philistine, whom you killed in the valley of Elah, is here wrapped in a cloth behind the ephod. If you would like to take that, take it, for there is no other except that here." David said, "There is none like that. Give it to me." ¹⁰David arose and fled that day for fear of Saul, and went to Achish the king of Gath. ¹¹The servants of Achish said to him, "Isn't this David the king of the land? Didn't they sing to one another about him in dances, saying, 'Saul has slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands?'" ¹²David laid up these words in his heart, and was very afraid of Achish the king of Gath. ¹³He changed his behavior before them and pretended to be insane in their hands, and scribbled on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down on his beard. ¹⁴Then Achish said to his servants, "Look, you see the man is insane. Why then have you brought him

to me? ¹⁵Do I lack madmen, that you have brought this fellow to play the madman in my presence? Should this fellow come into my house?"

22David therefore departed from there and escaped to Adullam's cave. When his brothers and all his father's house heard it, they went down there to him. ²Everyone who was in distress, everyone who was in debt, and everyone who was discontented gathered themselves to him; and he became captain over them. There were with him about four hundred men. ³David went from there to Mizpeh of Moab; and he said to the king of Moab, "Please let my father and my mother come out to you, until I know what God will do for me." ⁴He brought them before the king of Moab; and they lived with him all the time that David was in the stronghold. ⁵The prophet Gad said to David, "Don't stay in the stronghold. Depart, and go into the land of Judah." Then David departed, and came into the forest of Hereth. ⁶Saul heard that David was discovered, with the men who were with him. Now Saul was sitting in Gibeah, under the tamarisk tree in Ramah, with his spear in his hand, and all his servants were standing around him. ⁷Saul said to his servants who stood around him, "Hear now, you Benjamites! Will the son of Jesse give everyone of you fields and vineyards? Will he make you all captains of thousands and captains of hundreds? ⁸Is that why all of you have conspired against me, and there is no one who discloses to me when my son makes a treaty with the son of Jesse, and there is none of you who is sorry for me, or discloses to me that my son has stirred up my servant against me, to lie in wait, as it is today?" ⁹Then Doeg the Edomite, who stood by the servants of Saul, answered and said, "I saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to Ahimelech the son of Ahitub. ¹⁰He inquired of the LORD for him, gave him food, and gave him the sword of Goliath the Philistine." ¹¹Then the king sent to call Ahimelech the priest, the son of Ahitub, and all his father's house, the priests who were in Nob; and they all came to the king. ¹²Saul said, "Hear now, you son of Ahitub." He answered, "Here I am, my lord." ¹³Saul said to him, "Why have you conspired against me, you and the son of Jesse, in that you have given him bread, and a sword, and have inquired of God for him, that he should rise against me, to lie in wait, as it is today?" ¹⁴Then Ahimelech answered the king, and said, "Who among all your servants is so faithful as David, who is the king's son-in-law, captain of your body guard, and honored in your house? ¹⁵Have I today begun to inquire of God for him? Be it far from me! Don't let the king impute anything to his servant, nor to all the house of my father; for your servant knew nothing of all this, less or more." ¹⁶The king said, "You shall surely die, Ahimelech, you and all your father's house." ¹⁷The king said to the guard who stood about him, "Turn and kill the priests of the LORD, because their hand also is with David, and

because they knew that he fled and didn't disclose it to me." But the servants of the king wouldn't put out their hand to fall on the priests of the LORD. ¹⁸The king said to Doeg, "Turn and attack the priests!" Doeg the Edomite turned, and he attacked the priests, and he killed on that day eighty-five people who wore a linen ephod. ¹⁹He struck Nob, the city of the priests, with the edge of the sword—both men and women, children and nursing babies, and cattle, donkeys, and sheep, with the edge of the sword. ²⁰One of the sons of Ahimelech the son of Ahitub, named Abiathar, escaped and fled after David. ²¹Abiathar told David that Saul had slain the LORD's priests. ²²David said to Abiathar, "I knew on that day, when Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell Saul. I am responsible for the death of all the persons of your father's house. ²³Stay with me. Don't be afraid, for he who seeks my life seeks your life. You will be safe with me."

23David was told, "Behold, the Philistines are fighting against Keilah, and are robbing the threshing floors." ²Therefore David inquired of the LORD, saying, "Shall I go and strike these Philistines?" The LORD said to David, "Go strike the Philistines, and save Keilah." ³David's men said to him, "Behold, we are afraid here in Judah. How much more then if we go to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines?" ⁴Then David inquired of the LORD yet again. The LORD answered him, and said, "Arise, go down to Keilah; for I will deliver the Philistines into your hand." ⁵David and his men went to Keilah and fought with the Philistines, and brought away their livestock, and killed them with a great slaughter. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah. ⁶When Abiathar the son of Ahimelech fled to David to Keilah, he came down with an ephod in his hand. ⁷Saul was told that David had come to Keilah. Saul said, "God has delivered him into my hand, for he is shut in by entering into a town that has gates and bars." ⁸Saul summoned all the people to war, to go down to Keilah to besiege David and his men. ⁹David knew that Saul was devising mischief against him. He said to Abiathar the priest, "Bring the ephod here." ¹⁰Then David said, "O LORD, the God of Israel, your servant has surely heard that Saul seeks to come to Keilah to destroy the city for my sake. ¹¹Will the men of Keilah deliver me up into his hand? Will Saul come down, as your servant has heard? LORD, the God of Israel, I beg you, tell your servant." The LORD said, "He will come down." ¹²Then David said, "Will the men of Keilah deliver me and my men into the hand of Saul?" The LORD said, "They will deliver you up." ¹³Then David and his men, who were about six hundred, arose and departed out of Keilah and went wherever they could go. Saul was told that David had escaped from Keilah; and he gave up going there. ¹⁴David stayed in the wilderness in the strongholds, and remained in the hill country in the wilderness of Ziph. Saul sought him every

day, but God didn't deliver him into his hand. ¹⁵David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life. David was in the wilderness of Ziph in the woods. ¹⁶Jonathan, Saul's son, arose and went to David into the woods, and strengthened his hand in God. ¹⁷He said to him, "Don't be afraid, for the hand of Saul my father won't find you; and you will be king over Israel, and I will be next to you; and Saul my father knows that also." ¹⁸They both made a covenant before the LORD. Then David stayed in the woods and Jonathan went to his house. ¹⁹Then the Ziphites came up to Saul to Gibeah, saying, "Doesn't David hide himself with us in the strongholds in the woods, in the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of the desert?" ²⁰Now therefore, O king, come down. According to all the desire of your soul to come down; and our part will be to deliver him up into the king's hand." ²¹Saul said, "You are blessed by the LORD, for you have had compassion on me. ²²Please go make yet more sure, and know and see his place where his haunt is, and who has seen him there; for I have been told that he is very cunning. ²³See therefore, and take knowledge of all the lurking places where he hides himself; and come again to me with certainty, and I will go with you. It shall happen, if he is in the land, that I will search him out among all the thousands of Judah." ²⁴They arose, and went to Ziph before Saul; but David and his men were in the wilderness of Maon, in the Arabah on the south of the desert. ²⁵Saul and his men went to seek him. When David was told, he went down to the rock, and stayed in the wilderness of Maon. When Saul heard that, he pursued David in the wilderness of Maon. ²⁶Saul went on this side of the mountain, and David and his men on that side of the mountain; and David hurried to get away for fear of Saul, for Saul and his men surrounded David and his men to take them. ²⁷But a messenger came to Saul, saying, "Hurry and come, for the Philistines have made a raid on the land!" ²⁸So Saul returned from pursuing David, and went against the Philistines. Therefore they called that place Sela Hammahlekoth. ^{xx} ²⁹David went up from there and lived in the strongholds of En Gedi.

24When Saul had returned from following the Philistines, he was told, "Behold, David is in the wilderness of En Gedi." ²Then Saul took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and went to seek David and his men on the rocks of the wild goats. ³He came to the sheep pens by the way, where there was a cave; and Saul went in to relieve himself. Now David and his men were staying in the innermost parts of the cave. ⁴David's men said to him, "Behold, the day of which the LORD said to you, 'Behold, I will deliver your enemy into your hand, and you shall do to him as it shall seem good to you.'" Then David arose and cut off the skirt of Saul's robe secretly. ⁵Afterward, David's heart struck him because he had cut off Saul's skirt. ⁶He said

to his men, "The LORD forbid that I should do this thing to my lord, the LORD's anointed, to stretch out my hand against him, since he is the LORD's anointed." ⁷So David checked his men with these words, and didn't allow them to rise against Saul. Saul rose up out of the cave, and went on his way. ⁸David also arose afterward, and went out of the cave and cried after Saul, saying, "My lord the king!" When Saul looked behind him, David bowed with his face to the earth, and showed respect. ⁹David said to Saul, "Why do you listen to men's words, saying, 'Behold, David seeks to harm you?' ¹⁰Behold, today your eyes have seen how the LORD had delivered you today into my hand in the cave. Some urged me to kill you, but I spared you. I said, 'I will not stretch out my hand against my lord, for he is the LORD's anointed.' ¹¹Moreover, my father, behold, yes, see the skirt of your robe in my hand; for in that I cut off the skirt of your robe and didn't kill you, know and see that there is neither evil nor disobedience in my hand. I have not sinned against you, though you hunt for my life to take it. ¹²May the LORD judge between me and you, and may the LORD avenge me of you; but my hand will not be on you. ¹³As the proverb of the ancients says, 'Out of the wicked comes wickedness;' but my hand will not be on you. ¹⁴Against whom has the king of Israel come out? Whom do you pursue? A dead dog? A flea? ¹⁵May the LORD therefore be judge, and give sentence between me and you, and see, and plead my cause, and deliver me out of your hand." ¹⁶It came to pass, when David had finished speaking these words to Saul, that Saul said, "Is that your voice, my son David?" Saul lifted up his voice and wept. ¹⁷He said to David, "You are more righteous than I; for you have done good to me, whereas I have done evil to you. ¹⁸You have declared today how you have dealt well with me, because when the LORD had delivered me up into your hand, you didn't kill me. ¹⁹For if a man finds his enemy, will he let him go away unharmed? Therefore may the LORD reward you good for that which you have done to me today. ²⁰Now, behold, I know that you will surely be king, and that the kingdom of Israel will be established in your hand. ²¹Swear now therefore to me by the LORD that you will not cut off my offspring after me, and that you will not destroy my name out of my father's house." ²²David swore to Saul. Saul went home, but David and his men went up to the stronghold.

25Samuel died; and all Israel gathered themselves together and mourned for him, and buried him at his house at Ramah. Then David arose and went down to the wilderness of Paran. ²There was a man in Maon whose possessions were in Carmel; and the man was very great. He had three thousand sheep and a thousand goats; and he was shearing his sheep in Carmel. ³Now the name of the man was Nabal; and the name of his wife Abigail. This woman was intelligent and had a beautiful face; but the man was

^{xx}"Sela Hammahlekoth" means "rock of parting".

surly and evil in his doings. He was of the house of Caleb. ⁴David heard in the wilderness that Nabal was shearing his sheep. ⁵David sent ten young men; and David said to the young men, "Go up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and greet him in my name." ⁶Tell him, 'Long life to you! Peace be to you! Peace be to your house! Peace be to all that you have!' ⁷Now I have heard that you have shearers. Your shepherds have now been with us, and we didn't harm them. Nothing was missing from them all the time they were in Carmel. ⁸Ask your young men, and they will tell you. Therefore let the young men find favor in your eyes, for we come on a good day. Please give whatever comes to your hand to your servants and to your son David.'" ⁹When David's young men came, they spoke to Nabal all those words in the name of David, and waited. ¹⁰Nabal answered David's servants and said, "Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. ¹¹Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don't know where they come from?" ¹²So David's young men turned on their way and went back, and came and told him all these words. ¹³David said to his men, "Every man put on his sword!" Every man put on his sword. David also put on his sword. About four hundred men followed David, and two hundred stayed by the baggage. ¹⁴But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal's wife, saying, "Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to greet our master; and he insulted them. ¹⁵But the men were very good to us, and we were not harmed, and we didn't miss anything as long as we went with them, when we were in the fields. ¹⁶They were a wall to us both by night and by day, all the while we were with them keeping the sheep. ¹⁷Now therefore know and consider what you will do; for evil is determined against our master and against all his house, for he is such a worthless fellow that one can't speak to him." ¹⁸Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs ^{xxi} of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. ¹⁹She said to her young men, "Go on before me. Behold, I am coming after you." But she didn't tell her husband, Nabal. ²⁰As she rode on her donkey, and came down hidden by the mountain, behold, David and his men came down toward her, and she met them. ²¹Now David had said, "Surely in vain I have kept all that this fellow has in the wilderness, so that nothing was missed of all that pertained to him. He has returned me evil for good. ²²God do so to the enemies of David, and more also, if I leave of all that belongs to him by the morning light so much as one who urinates on a wall." ^{xxii} ²³When Abigail saw David, she hurried and got off her donkey, and fell before David on her face and

bowed herself to the ground. ²⁴She fell at his feet and said, "On me, my lord, on me be the blame! Please let your servant speak in your ears. Hear the words of your servant. ²⁵Please don't let my lord pay attention to this worthless fellow, Nabal, for as his name is, so is he. Nabal ^{xxiii} is his name, and folly is with him; but I, your servant, didn't see my lord's young men whom you sent. ²⁶Now therefore, my lord, as the LORD lives and as your soul lives, since the LORD has withheld you from blood guiltiness and from avenging yourself with your own hand, now therefore let your enemies and those who seek evil to my lord be as Nabal. ²⁷Now this present which your servant has brought to my lord, let it be given to the young men who follow my lord. ²⁸Please forgive the trespass of your servant. For the LORD will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord fights the LORD's battles. Evil will not be found in you all your days. ²⁹Though men may rise up to pursue you and to seek your soul, yet the soul of my lord will be bound in the bundle of life with the LORD your God. He will sling out the souls of your enemies as from a sling's pocket. ³⁰It will come to pass, when the LORD has done to my lord according to all the good that he has spoken concerning you, and has appointed you prince over Israel, ³¹that this shall be no grief to you, nor offense of heart to my lord, either that you have shed blood without cause, or that my lord has avenged himself. When the LORD has dealt well with my lord, then remember your servant." ³²David said to Abigail, "Blessed is the LORD, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! ³³Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand. ³⁴For indeed, as the LORD the God of Israel lives, who has withheld me from harming you, unless you had hurried and come to meet me, surely there wouldn't have been left to Nabal by the morning light so much as one who urinates on a wall." ^{xxiv} ³⁵So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, "Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice and have granted your request." ³⁶Abigail came to Nabal; and behold, he held a feast in his house like the feast of a king. Nabal's heart was merry within him, for he was very drunk. Therefore she told him nothing until the morning light. ³⁷In the morning, when the wine had gone out of Nabal, his wife told him these things; and his heart died within him, and he became as a stone. ³⁸About ten days later, the LORD struck Nabal, so that he died. ³⁹When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, "Blessed is the LORD, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil. The LORD has returned the evildoing of Nabal on his own head." David sent and spoke concerning Abigail, to take her to himself

^{xxi}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

^{xxii}or, male.

^{xxiii}"Nabal" means "foolish".

^{xxiv}or, one male.

as wife. ⁴⁰When David's servants had come to Abigail to Carmel, they spoke to her, saying, "David has sent us to you, to take you to him as wife." ⁴¹She arose and bowed herself with her face to the earth, and said, "Behold, your servant is a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my lord." ⁴²Abigail hurriedly arose and rode on a donkey with her five maids who followed her; and she went after the messengers of David, and became his wife. ⁴³David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they both became his wives. ⁴⁴Now Saul had given Michal his daughter, David's wife, to Palti the son of Laish, who was of Gallim.

26 The Ziphites came to Saul to Gibeah, saying, "Doesn't David hide himself in the hill of Hachilah, which is before the desert?" ²Then Saul arose and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, having three thousand chosen men of Israel with him, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph. ³Saul encamped in the hill of Hachilah, which is before the desert, by the way. But David stayed in the wilderness, and he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness. ⁴David therefore sent out spies, and understood that Saul had certainly come. ⁵Then David arose and came to the place where Saul had encamped; and David saw the place where Saul lay, with Abner the son of Ner, the captain of his army. Saul lay within the place of the wagons, and the people were encamped around him. ⁶Then David answered and said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother of Joab, saying, "Who will go down with me to Saul to the camp?" Abishai said, "I will go down with you." ⁷So David and Abishai came to the people by night; and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the place of the wagons, with his spear stuck in the ground at his head; and Abner and the people lay around him. ⁸Then Abishai said to David, "God has delivered up your enemy into your hand today. Now therefore please let me strike him with the spear to the earth at one stroke, and I will not strike him the second time." ⁹David said to Abishai, "Don't destroy him, for who can stretch out his hand against the LORD's anointed, and be guiltless?" ¹⁰David said, "As the LORD lives, the LORD will strike him; or his day shall come to die, or he shall go down into battle and perish." ¹¹The LORD forbid that I should stretch out my hand against the LORD's anointed; but now please take the spear that is at his head and the jar of water, and let's go." ¹²So David took the spear and the jar of water from Saul's head, and they went away. No man saw it, or knew it, nor did any awake; for they were all asleep, because a deep sleep from the LORD had fallen on them. ¹³Then David went over to the other side, and stood on the top of the mountain far away, a great space being between them; ¹⁴and David cried to the people, and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, "Don't you answer, Abner?" Then Abner answered, "Who are you who calls to the king?" ¹⁵David said to Abner, "Aren't you a man?

Who is like you in Israel? Why then have you not kept watch over your lord the king? For one of the people came in to destroy your lord the king. ¹⁶This thing isn't good that you have done. As the LORD lives, you are worthy to die, because you have not kept watch over your lord, the LORD's anointed. Now see where the king's spear is, and the jar of water that was at his head." ¹⁷Saul recognized David's voice, and said, "Is this your voice, my son David?" David said, "It is my voice, my lord, O king." ¹⁸He said, "Why does my lord pursue his servant? For what have I done? What evil is in my hand?" ¹⁹Now therefore, please let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If it is so that the LORD has stirred you up against me, let him accept an offering. But if it is the children of men, they are cursed before the LORD; for they have driven me out today that I shouldn't cling to the LORD's inheritance, saying, 'Go, serve other gods!' ²⁰Now therefore, don't let my blood fall to the earth away from the presence of the LORD; for the king of Israel has come out to seek a flea, as when one hunts a partridge in the mountains." ²¹Then Saul said, "I have sinned. Return, my son David; for I will no more do you harm, because my life was precious in your eyes today. Behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly." ²²David answered, "Behold the spear, O king! Let one of the young men come over and get it." ²³The LORD will render to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness; because the LORD delivered you into my hand today, and I wouldn't stretch out my hand against the LORD's anointed. ²⁴Behold, as your life was respected today in my eyes, so let my life be respected in the LORD's eyes, and let him deliver me out of all oppression." ²⁵Then Saul said to David, "You are blessed, my son David. You will both do mightily, and will surely prevail." So David went his way, and Saul returned to his place.

27 David said in his heart, "I will now perish one day by the hand of Saul. There is nothing better for me than that I should escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul will despair of me, to seek me any more in all the borders of Israel. So I will escape out of his hand." ²David arose and passed over, he and the six hundred men who were with him, to Achish the son of Maach, king of Gath. ³David lived with Achish at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, even David with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess and Abigail the Carmelitess, Nabal's wife. ⁴Saul was told that David had fled to Gath, so he stopped looking for him. ⁵David said to Achish, "If now I have found favor in your eyes, let them give me a place in one of the cities in the country, that I may dwell there. For why should your servant dwell in the royal city with you?" ⁶Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: therefore Ziklag belongs to the kings of Judah to this day. ⁷The number of the days that David lived in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months. ⁸David and

his men went up and raided the Geshurites, the Girzites, and the Amalekites; for those were the inhabitants of the land who were of old, on the way to Shur, even to the land of Egypt. ⁹David struck the land, and saved no man or woman alive, and took away the sheep, the cattle, the donkeys, the camels, and the clothing. Then he returned, and came to Achish. ¹⁰Achish said, "Against whom have you made a raid today?" David said, "Against the South of Judah, against the South of the Jerahmeelites, and against the South of the Kenites." ¹¹David saved neither man nor woman alive to bring them to Gath, saying, "Lest they should tell about us, saying, 'David did this, and this has been his way all the time he has lived in the country of the Philistines.'" ¹²Achish believed David, saying, "He has made his people Israel utterly to abhor him. Therefore he will be my servant forever."

28In those days, the Philistines gathered their armies together for warfare, to fight with Israel. Achish said to David, "Know assuredly that you will go out with me in the army, you and your men." ²David said to Achish, "Therefore you will know what your servant can do." Achish said to David, "Therefore I will make you my bodyguard forever." ³Now Samuel was dead, and all Israel had mourned for him and buried him in Ramah, even in his own city. Saul had sent away those who had familiar spirits and the wizards out of the land. ⁴The Philistines gathered themselves together, and came and encamped in Shunem; and Saul gathered all Israel together, and they encamped in Gilboa. ⁵When Saul saw the army of the Philistines, he was afraid, and his heart trembled greatly. ⁶When Saul inquired of the LORD, the LORD didn't answer him by dreams, by Urim, or by prophets. ⁷Then Saul said to his servants, "Seek for me a woman who has a familiar spirit, that I may go to her and inquire of her." His servants said to him, "Behold, there is a woman who has a familiar spirit at Endor." ⁸Saul disguised himself and put on other clothing, and went, he and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night. Then he said, "Please consult for me by the familiar spirit, and bring me up whomever I shall name to you." ⁹The woman said to him, "Behold, you know what Saul has done, how he has cut off those who have familiar spirits and the wizards out of the land. Why then do you lay a snare for my life, to cause me to die?" ¹⁰Saul swore to her by the LORD, saying, "As the LORD lives, no punishment will happen to you for this thing." ¹¹Then the woman said, "Whom shall I bring up to you?" He said, "Bring Samuel up for me." ¹²When the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice; and the woman spoke to Saul, saying, "Why have you deceived me? For you are Saul!" ¹³The king said to her, "Don't be afraid! What do you see?" The woman said to Saul, "I see a god coming up out of the earth." ¹⁴He said to her, "What does he look like?" She said, "An old man comes

up. He is covered with a robe." Saul perceived that it was Samuel, and he bowed with his face to the ground, and showed respect. ¹⁵Samuel said to Saul, "Why have you disturbed me, to bring me up?" Saul answered, "I am very distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and God has departed from me, and answers me no more, by prophets, or by dreams. Therefore I have called you, that you may make known to me what I shall do." ¹⁶Samuel said, "Why then do you ask me, since the LORD has departed from you and has become your adversary?" ¹⁷The LORD has done to you as he spoke by me. The LORD has torn the kingdom out of your hand and given it to your neighbor, even to David. ¹⁸Because you didn't obey the LORD's voice, and didn't execute his fierce wrath on Amalek, therefore the LORD has done this thing to you today. ¹⁹Moreover the LORD will deliver Israel also with you into the hand of the Philistines; and tomorrow you and your sons will be with me. The LORD will deliver the army of Israel also into the hand of the Philistines." ²⁰Then Saul fell immediately his full length on the earth, and was terrified, because of Samuel's words. There was no strength in him, for he had eaten no bread all day long or all night long. ²¹The woman came to Saul and saw that he was very troubled, and said to him, "Behold, your servant has listened to your voice, and I have put my life in my hand, and have listened to your words which you spoke to me. ²²Now therefore, please listen also to the voice of your servant, and let me set a morsel of bread before you. Eat, that you may have strength when you go on your way." ²³But he refused, and said, "I will not eat." But his servants, together with the woman, constrained him; and he listened to their voice. So he arose from the earth and sat on the bed. ²⁴The woman had a fattened calf in the house. She hurried and killed it; and she took flour and kneaded it, and baked unleavened bread of it. ²⁵She brought it before Saul and before his servants, and they ate. Then they rose up and went away that night.

29Now the Philistines gathered together all their armies to Aphek; and the Israelites encamped by the spring which is in Jezreel. ²The lords of the Philistines passed on by hundreds and by thousands; and David and his men passed on in the rear with Achish. ³Then the princes of the Philistines said, "What about these Hebrews?" Achish said to the princes of the Philistines, "Isn't this David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, who has been with me these days, or rather these years? I have found no fault in him since he fell away until today." ⁴But the princes of the Philistines were angry with him; and the princes of the Philistines said to him, "Make the man return, that he may go back to his place where you have appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, lest in the battle he become an adversary to us. For with what should this fellow reconcile himself to his lord? Should it not be with

the heads of these men? ⁵Isn't this David, of whom people sang to one another in dances, saying, 'Saul has slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands?'" ⁶Then Achish called David and said to him, "As the LORD lives, you have been upright, and your going out and your coming in with me in the army is good in my sight; for I have not found evil in you since the day of your coming to me to this day. Nevertheless, the lords don't favor you. ⁷Therefore now return, and go in peace, that you not displease the lords of the Philistines." ⁸David said to Achish, "But what have I done? What have you found in your servant so long as I have been before you to this day, that I may not go and fight against the enemies of my lord the king?" ⁹Achish answered David, "I know that you are good in my sight, as an angel of God. Notwithstanding, the princes of the Philistines have said, 'He shall not go up with us to the battle.' ¹⁰Therefore now rise up early in the morning with the servants of your lord who have come with you; and as soon as you are up early in the morning and have light, depart." ¹¹So David rose up early, he and his men, to depart in the morning, to return into the land of the Philistines; and the Philistines went up to Jezreel.

30When David and his men had come to Ziklag on the third day, the Amalekites had made a raid on the South and on Ziklag, and had struck Ziklag and burned it with fire, ²and had taken captive the women and all who were in it, both small and great. They didn't kill any, but carried them off and went their way. ³When David and his men came to the city, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, their sons, and their daughters were taken captive. ⁴Then David and the people who were with him lifted up their voice and wept until they had no more power to weep. ⁵David's two wives were taken captive, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite. ⁶David was greatly distressed, for the people spoke of stoning him, because the souls of all the people were grieved, every man for his sons and for his daughters; but David strengthened himself in the LORD his God. ⁷David said to Abiathar the priest, the son of Ahimelech, "Please bring the ephod here to me." Abiathar brought the ephod to David. ⁸David inquired of the LORD, saying, "If I pursue after this troop, will I overtake them?" He answered him, "Pursue, for you will surely overtake them, and will without fail recover all." ⁹So David went, he and the six hundred men who were with him, and came to the brook Besor, where those who were left behind stayed. ¹⁰But David pursued, he and four hundred men; for two hundred stayed behind, who were so faint that they couldn't go over the brook Besor. ¹¹They found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he ate; and they gave him water to drink. ¹²They gave him a piece of a cake of figs and two clusters of raisins. When he had eaten, his spirit came again to him; for he

had eaten no bread, and drank no water for three days and three nights. ¹³David asked him, "To whom do you belong? Where are you from?" He said, "I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I got sick. ¹⁴We made a raid on the South of the Cherethites, and on that which belongs to Judah, and on the South of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire." ¹⁵David said to him, "Will you bring me down to this troop?" He said, "Swear to me by God that you will not kill me and not deliver me up into the hands of my master, and I will bring you down to this troop." ¹⁶When he had brought him down, behold, they were spread around over all the ground, eating, drinking, and dancing, because of all the great plunder that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah. ¹⁷David struck them from the twilight even to the evening of the next day. Not a man of them escaped from there, except four hundred young men who rode on camels and fled. ¹⁸David recovered all that the Amalekites had taken, and David rescued his two wives. ¹⁹There was nothing lacking to them, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither plunder, nor anything that they had taken. David brought them all back. ²⁰David took all the flocks and the herds, which they drove before those other livestock, and said, "This is David's plunder." ²¹David came to the two hundred men, who were so faint that they could not follow David, whom also they had made to stay at the brook Besor; and they went out to meet David, and to meet the people who were with him. When David came near to the people, he greeted them. ²²Then all the wicked men and worthless fellows of those who went with David answered and said, "Because they didn't go with us, we will not give them anything of the plunder that we have recovered, except to every man his wife and his children, that he may lead them away and depart." ²³Then David said, "Do not do so, my brothers, with that which the LORD has given to us, who has preserved us, and delivered the troop that came against us into our hand. ²⁴Who will listen to you in this matter? For as his share is who goes down to the battle, so shall his share be who stays with the baggage. They shall share alike." ²⁵It was so from that day forward that he made it a statute and an ordinance for Israel to this day. ²⁶When David came to Ziklag, he sent some of the plunder to the elders of Judah, even to his friends, saying, "Behold, a present for you from the plunder of the LORD's enemies." ²⁷He sent it to those who were in Bethel, to those who were in Ramoth of the South, to those who were in Jattir, ²⁸to those who were in Aroer, to those who were in Siphmoth, to those who were in Eshtemoa, ²⁹to those who were in Racal, to those who were in the cities of the Jerahmeelites, to those who were in the cities of the Kenites, ³⁰to those who were in Hormah, to those who were in Borashan, to those who were in Athach, ³¹to those who were in Hebron,

and to all the places where David himself and his men used to stay.

31Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain on Mount Gilboa. ²The Philistines overtook Saul and his sons; and the Philistines killed Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malchishua, the sons of Saul. ³The battle went hard against Saul, and the archers overtook him; and he was greatly distressed by reason of the archers. ⁴Then Saul said to his armor bearer, "Draw your sword, and thrust me through with it, lest these uncircumcised come and thrust me through and abuse me!" But his armor bearer would not, for he was terrified. Therefore Saul took his sword and fell on it. ⁵When his armor bearer saw that Saul was dead, he likewise fell on his sword, and died with him. ⁶So Saul died with his three sons, his armor bearer, and all his men that same day together. ⁷When the men of Israel who were on the other side of the valley, and those who were beyond the Jordan, saw that the men of Israel fled and that Saul and his sons were dead, they abandoned the cities and fled; and the Philistines came and lived in them. ⁸On the next day, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, they found Saul and his three sons fallen on Mount Gilboa. ⁹They cut off his head, stripped off his armor, and sent into the land of the Philistines all around, to carry the news to the house of their idols and to the people. ¹⁰They put his armor in the house of the Ashtaroth, and they fastened his body to the wall of Beth Shan. ¹¹When the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead heard what the Philistines had done to Saul, ¹²all the valiant men arose, went all night, and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth Shan; and they came to Jabesh and burned them there. ¹³They took their bones and buried them under the tamarisk ^{xxv} tree in Jabesh, and fasted seven days.

^{xxv}or, salt cedar

2 Samuel

¹After the death of Saul, when David had returned from the slaughter of the Amalekites, and David had stayed two days in Ziklag, ²on the third day, behold, ⁱ a man came out of the camp from Saul, with his clothes torn and earth on his head. When he came to David, he fell to the earth and showed respect. ³David said to him, "Where do you come from?" He said to him, "I have escaped out of the camp of Israel." ⁴David said to him, "How did it go? Please tell me." He answered, "The people have fled from the battle, and many of the people also have fallen and are dead. Saul and Jonathan his son are dead also." ⁵David said to the young man who told him, "How do you know that Saul and Jonathan his son are dead?" ⁶The young man who told him said, "As I happened by chance on Mount Gilboa, behold, Saul was leaning on his spear; and behold, the chariots and the horsemen followed close behind him. ⁷When he looked behind him, he saw me and called to me. I answered, 'Here I am.' ⁸He said to me, 'Who are you?' I answered him, 'I am an Amalekite.' ⁹He said to me, 'Please stand beside me, and kill me, for anguish has taken hold of me because my life lingers in me.' ¹⁰So I stood beside him and killed him, because I was sure that he could not live after he had fallen. I took the crown that was on his head and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them here to my lord." ¹¹Then David took hold on his clothes and tore them; and all the men who were with him did likewise. ¹²They mourned, wept, and fasted until evening for Saul and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of the LORD, ⁱⁱ and for the house of Israel, because they had fallen by the sword. ¹³David said to the young man who told him, "Where are you from?" He answered, "I am the son of a foreigner, an Amalekite." ¹⁴David said to him, "Why were you not afraid to stretch out your hand to destroy the LORD's anointed?" ¹⁵David called one of the young men and said, "Go near, and cut him down!" He struck him so that he died. ¹⁶David said to him, "Your blood be on your head, for your mouth has testified against you, saying, 'I have slain the LORD's anointed.'" ¹⁷David lamented with this lamentation over Saul and over

Jonathan his son ¹⁸(and he commanded them to teach the children of Judah the song of the bow; behold, it is written in the book of Jashar): ¹⁹"Your glory, Israel, was slain on your high places! How the mighty have fallen! ²⁰Don't tell it in Gath. Don't publish it in the streets of Ashkelon, lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised triumph. ²¹You mountains of Gilboa, let there be no dew or rain on you, and no fields of offerings; For there the shield of the mighty was defiled and cast away, The shield of Saul was not anointed with oil. ²²From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty, Jonathan's bow didn't turn back. Saul's sword didn't return empty. ²³Saul and Jonathan were lovely and pleasant in their lives. In their death, they were not divided. They were swifter than eagles. They were stronger than lions. ²⁴You daughters of Israel, weep over Saul, who clothed you delicately in scarlet, who put ornaments of gold on your clothing. ²⁵How the mighty have fallen in the middle of the battle! Jonathan was slain on your high places. ²⁶I am distressed for you, my brother Jonathan. You have been very pleasant to me. Your love to me was wonderful, surpassing the love of women. ²⁷How the mighty have fallen, and the weapons of war have perished!"

²After this, David inquired of the LORD, saying, "Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah?" The LORD said to him, "Go up." David said, "Where shall I go up?" He said, "To Hebron." ²So David went up there with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite. ³David brought up his men who were with him, every man with his household. They lived in the cities of Hebron. ⁴The men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. They told David, "The men of Jabesh Gilead were those who buried Saul." ⁵David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead, and said to them, "Blessed are you by the LORD, that you have shown this kindness to your lord, even to Saul, and have buried him. ⁶Now may the LORD show loving kindness and truth to you. I also will reward you for this kindness, because you have done this thing. ⁷Now therefore let your hands be strong, and be valiant; for Saul your lord is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them." ⁸Now Abner the son

ⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

of Ner, captain of Saul's army, had taken Ishbosheth the son of Saul and brought him over to Mahanaim. ⁹He made him king over Gilead, over the Ashurites, over Jezreel, over Ephraim, over Benjamin, and over all Israel. ¹⁰Ishbosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David. ¹¹The time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months. ¹²Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ishbosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon. ¹³Joab the son of Zeruiah and David's servants went out, and met them by the pool of Gibeon; and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool and the other on the other side of the pool. ¹⁴Abner said to Joab, "Please let the young men arise and compete before us!" Joab said, "Let them arise!" ¹⁵Then they arose and went over by number: twelve for Benjamin and for Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of David's servants. ¹⁶They each caught his opponent by the head and thrust his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together. Therefore that place in Gibeon was called Helkath Hazzurim. ⁱⁱⁱ ¹⁷The battle was very severe that day; and Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before David's servants. ¹⁸The three sons of Zeruiah were there: Joab, Abishai, and Asahel. Asahel was as light of foot as a wild gazelle. ¹⁹Asahel pursued Abner. He didn't turn to the right hand or to the left from following Abner. ²⁰Then Abner looked behind him and said, "Is that you, Asahel?" He answered, "It is." ²¹Abner said to him, "Turn away to your right hand or to your left, and grab one of the young men, and take his armor." But Asahel would not turn away from following him. ²²Abner said again to Asahel, "Turn away from following me. Why should I strike you to the ground? How then could I look Joab your brother in the face?" ²³However, he refused to turn away. Therefore Abner with the back end of the spear struck him in the body, so that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there and died in the same place. As many as came to the place where Asahel fell down and died stood still. ²⁴But Joab and Abishai pursued Abner. The sun went down when they had come to the hill of Ammah, that lies before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon. ²⁵The children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner and became one band, and stood on the top of a hill. ²⁶Then Abner called to Joab, and said, "Shall the sword devour forever? Don't you know that it will be bitterness in the latter end? How long will it be then, before you ask the people to return from following their brothers?" ²⁷Joab said, "As God ^{iv} lives, if you had not spoken, surely then in the morning the people would have gone away, and not each followed his brother." ²⁸So Joab blew the shofar; and all the people stood still and pursued Israel no more, and they fought no more. ²⁹Abner and his men went all

that night through the Arabah; and they passed over the Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and came to Mahanaim. ³⁰Joab returned from following Abner; and when he had gathered all the people together, nineteen men of David's and Asahel were missing. ³¹But David's servants had struck Benjamin Abner's men so that three hundred sixty men died. ³²They took up Asahel and buried him in the tomb of his father, which was in Bethlehem. Joab and his men went all night, and the day broke on them at Hebron.

3Now there was long war between Saul's house and David's house. David grew stronger and stronger, but Saul's house grew weaker and weaker. ²Sons were born to David in Hebron. His firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; ³and his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmi king of Geshur; ⁴and the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital; ⁵and the sixth, Ithream, of Eglah, David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron. ⁶While there was war between Saul's house and David's house, Abner made himself strong in Saul's house. ⁷Now Saul had a concubine, whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah; and Ishbosheth said to Abner, "Why have you gone in to my father's concubine?" ⁸Then Abner was very angry about Ishbosheth's words, and said, "Am I a dog's head that belongs to Judah? Today I show kindness to your father Saul's house, to his brothers, and to his friends, and have not delivered you into the hand of David; and yet you charge me today with a fault concerning this woman! ⁹God do so to Abner, and more also, if, as the LORD has sworn to David, I don't do even so to him: ¹⁰to transfer the kingdom from Saul's house, and to set up David's throne over Israel and over Judah, from Dan even to Beersheba." ¹¹He could not answer Abner another word, because he was afraid of him. ¹²Abner sent messengers to David on his behalf, saying, "Whose is the land?" and saying, "Make your alliance with me, and behold, my hand will be with you to bring all Israel around to you." ¹³David said, "Good. I will make a treaty with you, but one thing I require of you. That is, you will not see my face unless you first bring Michal, Saul's daughter, when you come to see my face." ¹⁴David sent messengers to Ishbosheth, Saul's son, saying, "Deliver me my wife Michal, whom I was given to marry for one hundred foreskins of the Philistines." ¹⁵Ishbosheth sent and took her from her husband, Paltiel the son of Laish. ¹⁶Her husband went with her, weeping as he went, and followed her to Bahurim. Then Abner said to him, "Go! Return!" and he returned. ¹⁷Abner had communication with the elders of Israel, saying, "In times past, you sought for David to be king over you. ¹⁸Now then do it! For the LORD has spoken of David, saying, 'By the hand of my servant David, I will save my people Israel out of the

ⁱⁱⁱHelkath Hazzurim" means "field of daggers".

^{iv}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim".

hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies.”¹⁹ Abner also spoke in the ears of Benjamin; and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel and to the whole house of Benjamin.²⁰ So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. David made Abner and the men who were with him a feast.²¹ Abner said to David, “I will arise and go, and will gather all Israel to my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign over all that your soul desires.” David sent Abner away; and he went in peace.²² Behold, David’s servants and Joab came from a raid and brought in a great plunder with them; but Abner was not with David in Hebron, for he had sent him away, and he had gone in peace.²³ When Joab and all the army who was with him had come, they told Joab, “Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he has sent him away, and he has gone in peace.”²⁴ Then Joab came to the king and said, “What have you done? Behold, Abner came to you. Why is it that you have sent him away, and he is already gone?”²⁵ You know Abner the son of Ner. He came to deceive you, and to know your going out and your coming in, and to know all that you do.”²⁶ When Joab had come out from David, he sent messengers after Abner, and they brought him back from the well of Sirah; but David didn’t know it.²⁷ When Abner had returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside into the middle of the gate to speak with him quietly, and struck him there in the body, so that he died for the blood of Asahel his brother.²⁸ Afterward, when David heard it, he said, “I and my kingdom are guiltless before the LORD forever of the blood of Abner the son of Ner.”²⁹ Let it fall on the head of Joab and on all his father’s house. Let there not fail from the house of Joab one who has a discharge, or who is a leper, or who leans on a staff, or who falls by the sword, or who lacks bread.”³⁰ So Joab and Abishai his brother killed Abner, because he had killed their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle.³¹ David said to Joab and to all the people who were with him, “Tear your clothes, and clothe yourselves with sackcloth, and mourn in front of Abner.” King David followed the bier.³² They buried Abner in Hebron; and the king lifted up his voice and wept at Abner’s grave; and all the people wept.³³ The king lamented for Abner, and said, “Should Abner die as a fool dies?”³⁴ Your hands weren’t bound, and your feet weren’t put into fetters. As a man falls before the children of iniquity, so you fell.” All the people wept again over him.³⁵ All the people came to urge David to eat bread while it was yet day; but David swore, saying, “God do so to me, and more also, if I taste bread or anything else, until the sun goes down.”³⁶ All the people took notice of it, and it pleased them, as whatever the king did pleased all the people.³⁷ So all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to kill Abner the son of Ner.³⁸ The king said to his servants, “Don’t you know that a prince and a great

man has fallen today in Israel?”³⁹ I am weak today, though anointed king. These men, the sons of Zeruiah are too hard for me. May the LORD reward the evildoer according to his wickedness.”

4 When Saul’s son heard that Abner was dead in Hebron, his hands became feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled.² Saul’s son had two men who were captains of raiding bands. The name of one was Baanah and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin (for Beeroth also is considered a part of Benjamin; ³ and the Beerothites fled to Gittaim, and have lived as foreigners there until today).⁴ Now Jonathan, Saul’s son, had a son who was lame in his feet. He was five years old when the news came about Saul and Jonathan out of Jezreel; and his nurse picked him up and fled. As she hurried to flee, he fell and became lame. His name was Mephibosheth.⁵ The sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, went out and came at about the heat of the day to the house of Ishbosheth as he took his rest at noon.⁶ They came there into the middle of the house as though they would have fetched wheat, and they struck him in the body; and Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped.⁷ Now when they came into the house as he lay on his bed in his bedroom, they struck him, killed him, beheaded him, and took his head, and went by the way of the Arabah all night.⁸ They brought the head of Ishbosheth to David to Hebron, and said to the king, “Behold, the head of Ishbosheth, the son of Saul, your enemy, who sought your life! The LORD has avenged my lord the king today of Saul and of his offspring.”⁹ David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, and said to them, “As the LORD lives, who has redeemed my soul out of all adversity,¹⁰ when someone told me, ‘Behold, Saul is dead,’ thinking that he brought good news, I seized him and killed him in Ziklag, which was the reward I gave him for his news.”¹¹ How much more, when wicked men have slain a righteous person in his own house on his bed, should I not now require his blood from your hand, and rid the earth of you?”¹² David commanded his young men, and they killed them, cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up beside the pool in Hebron. But they took the head of Ishbosheth and buried it in Abner’s grave in Hebron.

5 Then all the tribes of Israel came to David at Hebron and spoke, saying, “Behold, we are your bone and your flesh.”² In times past, when Saul was king over us, it was you who led Israel out and in. The LORD said to you, ‘You will be shepherd of my people Israel, and you will be prince over Israel.’”³ So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron, and King David made a covenant with them in Hebron before the LORD; and they anointed

^vor, seed

David king over Israel. ⁴David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years. ⁵In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months, and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty-three years over all Israel and Judah. ⁶The king and his men went to Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land, who spoke to David, saying, “The blind and the lame will keep you out of here,” thinking, “David can’t come in here.” ⁷Nevertheless David took the stronghold of Zion. This is David’s city. ⁸David said on that day, “Whoever strikes the Jebusites, let him go up to the watercourse and strike those lame and blind, who are hated by David’s soul.” Therefore they say, “The blind and the lame can’t come into the house.” ⁹David lived in the stronghold, and called it David’s city. David built around from Millo and inward. ¹⁰David grew greater and greater, for the LORD, the God of Hosts, was with him. ¹¹Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, with cedar trees, carpenters, and masons; and they built David a house. ¹²David perceived that the LORD had established him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom for his people Israel’s sake. ¹³David took more concubines and wives for himself out of Jerusalem, after he had come from Hebron; and more sons and daughters were born to David. ¹⁴These are the names of those who were born to him in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, ¹⁵Ibhar, Elishua, Nepheg, Japhia, ¹⁶Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet. ¹⁷When the Philistines heard that they had anointed David king over Israel, all the Philistines went up to seek David, but David heard about it and went down to the stronghold. ¹⁸Now the Philistines had come and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim. ¹⁹David inquired of the LORD, saying, “Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will you deliver them into my hand?” The LORD said to David, “Go up; for I will certainly deliver the Philistines into your hand.” ²⁰David came to Baal Perazim, and David struck them there. Then he said, “The LORD has broken my enemies before me, like the breach of waters.” Therefore he called the name of that place Baal Perazim. ^{vi} ²¹They left their images there, and David and his men took them away. ²²The Philistines came up yet again and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim. ²³When David inquired of the LORD, he said, “You shall not go up. Circle around behind them, and attack them in front of the mulberry trees. ²⁴When you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then stir yourself up; for then the LORD has gone out before you to strike the army of the Philistines.” ²⁵David did so, as the LORD commanded him, and struck the Philistines all the way from Geba to Gezer.

⁶David again gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand. ²David arose and went with all the people who were with him from Baale Judah, to bring

up from there God’s ark, which is called by the Name, even the name of the LORD of Hosts who sits above the cherubim. ³They set God’s ark on a new cart, and brought it out of Abinadab’s house that was on the hill; and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drove the new cart. ⁴They brought it out of Abinadab’s house which was in the hill, with God’s ark; and Ahio went before the ark. ⁵David and all the house of Israel played before the LORD with all kinds of instruments made of cypress wood, with harps, with stringed instruments, with tambourines, with castanets, and with cymbals. ⁶When they came to the threshing floor of Nacon, Uzzah reached for God’s ark and took hold of it, for the cattle stumbled. ⁷The LORD’s anger burned against Uzzah, and God struck him there for his error; and he died there by God’s ark. ⁸David was displeased because the LORD had broken out against Uzzah; and he called that place Perez Uzzah ^{vii} to this day. ⁹David was afraid of the LORD that day; and he said, “How could the LORD’s ark come to me?” ¹⁰So David would not move the LORD’s ark to be with him in David’s city; but David carried it aside into Obed-Edom the Gittite’s house. ¹¹The LORD’s ark remained in Obed-Edom the Gittite’s house three months; and the LORD blessed Obed-Edom and all his house. ¹²King David was told, “The LORD has blessed the house of Obed-Edom, and all that belongs to him, because of God’s ark.” So David went and brought up God’s ark from the house of Obed-Edom into David’s city with joy. ¹³When those who bore the LORD’s ark had gone six paces, he sacrificed an ox and a fattened calf. ¹⁴David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was clothed in a linen ephod. ¹⁵So David and all the house of Israel brought up the LORD’s ark with shouting and with the sound of the shofar. ¹⁶As the LORD’s ark came into David’s city, Michal the daughter of Saul looked out through the window and saw King David leaping and dancing before the LORD; and she despised him in her heart. ¹⁷They brought in the LORD’s ark, and set it in its place in the middle of the tent that David had pitched for it; and David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before the LORD. ¹⁸When David had finished offering the burnt offering and the peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁹He gave to all the people, even among the whole multitude of Israel, both to men and women, to everyone a portion of bread, dates, and raisins. So all the people departed, each to his own house. ²⁰Then David returned to bless his household. Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and said, “How glorious the king of Israel was today, who uncovered himself today in the eyes of his servants’ maids, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovers himself!” ²¹David said to Michal, “It was before the LORD, who chose me above your father, and above all his house, to appoint me prince over the people of the

^{vi}“Baal Perazim” means “Lord who breaks out”.

^{vii}“Perez Uzzah” means “outbreak against Uzzah”.

LORD, over Israel. Therefore I will celebrate before the LORD. ²²I will be yet more undignified than this, and will be worthless in my own sight. But the maids of whom you have spoken will honor me.” ²³Michal the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death.

⁷When the king lived in his house, and the LORD had given him rest from all his enemies all around, ²the king said to Nathan the prophet, “See now, I dwell in a house of cedar, but God’s ark dwells within curtains.” ³Nathan said to the king, “Go, do all that is in your heart, for the LORD is with you.” ⁴That same night, the LORD’s word came to Nathan, saying, ⁵“Go and tell my servant David, ‘The LORD says, “Should you build me a house for me to dwell in?’ ⁶For I have not lived in a house since the day that I brought the children of Israel up out of Egypt, even to this day, but have moved around in a tent and in a tabernacle. ⁷In all places in which I have walked with all the children of Israel, did I say a word to anyone from the tribes of Israel whom I commanded to be shepherd of my people Israel, saying, ‘Why have you not built me a house of cedar?’”’ ⁸Now therefore tell my servant David this: ‘The LORD of Hosts says, “I took you from the sheep pen, from following the sheep, to be prince over my people, over Israel. ⁹I have been with you wherever you went, and have cut off all your enemies from before you. I will make you a great name, like the name of the great ones who are in the earth. ¹⁰I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place and be moved no more. The children of wickedness will not afflict them any more, as at the first, ¹¹and as from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. I will cause you to rest from all your enemies. Moreover the LORD tells you that the LORD will make you a house. ¹²When your days are fulfilled and you sleep with your fathers, I will set up your offspring after you, who will proceed out of your body, and I will establish his kingdom. ¹³He will build a house for my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever. ¹⁴I will be his father, and he will be my son. If he commits iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men and with the stripes of the children of men; ¹⁵but my loving kindness will not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before you. ¹⁶Your house and your kingdom will be made sure forever before you. Your throne will be established forever.”’” ¹⁷Nathan spoke to David all these words, and according to all this vision. ¹⁸Then David the king went in and sat before the LORD; and he said, “Who am I, Lord ^{viii} GOD, and what is my house, that you have brought me this far? ¹⁹This was yet a small thing in your eyes, Lord GOD, but you have spoken also of your servant’s house for a great while to come; and this among men, Lord GOD! ²⁰What more can David say to you? For you know your servant,

Lord GOD. ²¹For your word’s sake, and according to your own heart, you have worked all this greatness, to make your servant know it. ²²Therefore you are great, LORD God. For there is no one like you, neither is there any God besides you, according to all that we have heard with our ears. ²³What one nation in the earth is like your people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem to himself for a people, and to make himself a name, and to do great things for you, and awesome things for your land, before your people, whom you redeemed to yourself out of Egypt, from the nations and their gods? ²⁴You established for yourself your people Israel to be your people forever; and you, LORD, became their God. ²⁵“Now, LORD God, the word that you have spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house, confirm it forever, and do as you have spoken. ²⁶Let your name be magnified forever, saying, ‘The LORD of Hosts is God over Israel; and the house of your servant David will be established before you.’” ²⁷For you, LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, have revealed to your servant, saying, ‘I will build you a house.’ Therefore your servant has found in his heart to pray this prayer to you. ²⁸“Now, O Lord GOD, you are God, and your words are truth, and you have promised this good thing to your servant. ²⁹Now therefore, let it please you to bless the house of your servant, that it may continue forever before you; for you, Lord GOD, have spoken it. Let the house of your servant be blessed forever with your blessing.”

⁸After this, David struck the Philistines and subdued them; and David took the bridle of the mother city out of the hand of the Philistines. ²He defeated Moab, and measured them with the line, making them to lie down on the ground; and he measured two lines to put to death, and one full line to keep alive. The Moabites became servants to David, and brought tribute. ³David also struck Hadadezer the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to recover his dominion at the River. ⁴David took from him one thousand seven hundred horsemen and twenty thousand footmen. David hamstringed the chariot horses, but reserved enough of them for one hundred chariots. ⁵When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck twenty two thousand men of the Syrians. ⁶Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought tribute. The LORD gave victory to David wherever he went. ⁷David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem. ⁸From Betah and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, King David took a great quantity of bronze. ⁹When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the army of Hadadezer, ¹⁰then Toi sent Joram his son to King David to greet him and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and struck him; for Hadadezer had wars with Toi. Joram brought with him vessels of silver, vessels of gold, and ves-

^{viii}The word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

sels of bronze. ¹¹King David also dedicated these to the LORD, with the silver and gold that he dedicated of all the nations which he subdued— ¹²of Syria, of Moab, of the children of Ammon, of the Philistines, of Amalek, and of the plunder of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah. ¹³David earned a reputation when he returned from striking down eighteen thousand men of the Syrians in the Valley of Salt. ¹⁴He put garrisons in Edom. Throughout all Edom, he put garrisons, and all the Edomites became servants to David. The LORD gave victory to David wherever he went. ¹⁵David reigned over all Israel; and David executed justice and righteousness for all his people. ¹⁶Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army, Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder, ¹⁷Zadok the son of Ahitub and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar were priests, Seraiah was scribe, ¹⁸Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were chief ministers.

⁹David said, "Is there yet any who is left of Saul's house, that I may show him kindness for Jonathan's sake?" ²There was of Saul's house a servant whose name was Ziba, and they called him to David; and the king said to him, "Are you Ziba?" He said, "I am your servant." ³The king said, "Is there not yet any of Saul's house, that I may show the kindness of God to him?" Ziba said to the king, "Jonathan still has a son, who is lame in his feet." ⁴The king said to him, "Where is he?" Ziba said to the king, "Behold, he is in the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, in Lo Debar." ⁵Then King David sent and brought him out of the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, from Lo Debar. ⁶Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came to David, fell on his face, and showed respect. David said, "Mephibosheth?" He answered, "Behold, your servant!" ⁷David said to him, "Don't be afraid, for I will surely show you kindness for Jonathan your father's sake, and will restore to you all the land of Saul your father. You will eat bread at my table continually." ⁸He bowed down, and said, "What is your servant, that you should look at such a dead dog as I am?" ⁹Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "All that belonged to Saul and to all his house I have given to your master's son. ¹⁰Till the land for him—you, your sons, and your servants. Bring in the harvest, that your master's son may have bread to eat; but Mephibosheth your master's son will always eat bread at my table." Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. ¹¹Then Ziba said to the king, "According to all that my lord the king commands his servant, so your servant will do." So Mephibosheth ate at the king's table like one of the king's sons. ¹²Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was Mica. All who lived in Ziba's house were servants to Mephibosheth. ¹³So Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, for he ate continually at the king's table. He was lame in both his feet.

¹⁰After this, the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his place. ²David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father showed kindness to me." So David sent by his servants to comfort him concerning his father. David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon. ³But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun their lord, "Do you think that David honors your father, in that he has sent comforters to you? Hasn't David sent his servants to you to search the city, to spy it out, and to overthrow it?" ⁴So Hanun took David's servants, shaved off one half of their beards, and cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away. ⁵When they told David this, he sent to meet them, for the men were greatly ashamed. The king said, "Wait at Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return." ⁶When the children of Ammon saw that they had become odious to David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the Syrians of Beth Rehob and the Syrians of Zobah, twenty thousand footmen, and the king of Maacah with one thousand men, and the men of Tob twelve thousand men. ⁷When David heard of it, he sent Joab and all the army of the mighty men. ⁸The children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entrance of the gate. The Syrians of Zobah and of Rehob and the men of Tob and Maacah were by themselves in the field. ⁹Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel and put them in array against the Syrians. ¹⁰The rest of the people he committed into the hand of Abishai his brother; and he put them in array against the children of Ammon. ¹¹He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you shall help me; but if the children of Ammon are too strong for you, then I will come and help you. ¹²Be courageous, and let's be strong for our people and for the cities of our God; and may the LORD do what seems good to him." ¹³So Joab and the people who were with him came near to the battle against the Syrians, and they fled before him. ¹⁴When the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians had fled, they likewise fled before Abishai, and entered into the city. Then Joab returned from the children of Ammon and came to Jerusalem. ¹⁵When the Syrians saw that they were defeated by Israel, they gathered themselves together. ¹⁶Hadadezer sent and brought out the Syrians who were beyond the River; and they came to Helam, with Shobach the captain of the army of Hadadezer at their head. ¹⁷David was told that; and he gathered all Israel together, passed over the Jordan, and came to Helam. The Syrians set themselves in array against David and fought with him. ¹⁸The Syrians fled before Israel; and David killed seven hundred charioteers of the Syrians and forty thousand horsemen, and struck Shobach the captain of their army, so that he died there. ¹⁹When all the kings who were servants to Hadadezer saw that they were defeated before Israel, they made peace

with Israel and served them. So the Syrians were afraid to help the children of Ammon any more.

11At the return of the year, at the time when kings go out, David sent Joab and his servants with him, and all Israel; and they destroyed the children of Ammon and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem. ²At evening, David arose from his bed and walked on the roof of the king's house. From the roof, he saw a woman bathing, and the woman was very beautiful to look at. ³David sent and inquired after the woman. One said, "Isn't this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam, Uriah the Hittite's wife?" ⁴David sent messengers, and took her; and she came in to him, and he lay with her (for she was purified from her uncleanness); and she returned to her house. ⁵The woman conceived; and she sent and told David, and said, "I am with child." ⁶David sent to Joab, "Send me Uriah the Hittite." Joab sent Uriah to David. ⁷When Uriah had come to him, David asked him how Joab did, and how the people fared, and how the war prospered. ⁸David said to Uriah, "Go down to your house and wash your feet." Uriah departed out of the king's house, and a gift from the king was sent after him. ⁹But Uriah slept at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and didn't go down to his house. ¹⁰When they had told David, saying, "Uriah didn't go down to his house," David said to Uriah, "Haven't you come from a journey? Why didn't you go down to your house?" ¹¹Uriah said to David, "The ark, Israel, and Judah, are staying in tents; and my lord Joab and the servants of my lord are encamped in the open field. Shall I then go into my house to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? As you live, and as your soul lives, I will not do this thing!" ¹²David said to Uriah, "Stay here today also, and tomorrow I will let you depart." So Uriah stayed in Jerusalem that day and the next day. ¹³When David had called him, he ate and drank before him; and he made him drunk. At evening, he went out to lie on his bed with the servants of his lord, but didn't go down to his house. ¹⁴In the morning, David wrote a letter to Joab and sent it by the hand of Uriah. ¹⁵He wrote in the letter, saying, "Send Uriah to the forefront of the hottest battle, and retreat from him, that he may be struck and die." ¹⁶When Joab kept watch on the city, he assigned Uriah to the place where he knew that valiant men were. ¹⁷The men of the city went out and fought with Joab. Some of the people fell, even of David's servants; and Uriah the Hittite died also. ¹⁸Then Joab sent and told David all the things concerning the war; ¹⁹and he commanded the messenger, saying, "When you have finished telling all the things concerning the war to the king, ²⁰it shall be that, if the king's wrath arise, and he asks you, 'Why did you go so near to the city to fight? Didn't you know that they would shoot from the wall?' ²¹Who struck Abimelech the son of Jerubesheth? Didn't a woman cast an upper millstone on him from the

wall, so that he died at Thebez? Why did you go so near the wall?' then you shall say, 'Your servant Uriah the Hittite is also dead.'" ²²So the messenger went, and came and showed David all that Joab had sent him for. ²³The messenger said to David, "The men prevailed against us, and came out to us into the field; and we were on them even to the entrance of the gate. ²⁴The shooters shot at your servants from off the wall; and some of the king's servants are dead, and your servant Uriah the Hittite is also dead." ²⁵Then David said to the messenger, "Tell Joab, 'Don't let this thing displease you, for the sword devours one as well as another. Make your battle stronger against the city, and overthrow it.' Encourage him." ²⁶When Uriah's wife heard that Uriah her husband was dead, she mourned for her husband. ²⁷When the mourning was past, David sent and took her home to his house, and she became his wife and bore him a son. But the thing that David had done displeased the LORD.

12The LORD sent Nathan to David. He came to him, and said to him, "There were two men in one city: the one rich, and the other poor. ²The rich man had very many flocks and herds, ³but the poor man had nothing, except one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and raised. It grew up together with him and with his children. It ate of his own food, drank of his own cup, and lay in his bosom, and was like a daughter to him. ⁴A traveler came to the rich man, and he didn't want to take of his own flock and of his own herd to prepare for the wayfaring man who had come to him, but took the poor man's lamb and prepared it for the man who had come to him." ⁵David's anger burned hot against the man, and he said to Nathan, "As the LORD lives, the man who has done this deserves to die! ⁶He must restore the lamb fourfold, because he did this thing and because he had no pity!" ⁷Nathan said to David, "You are the man! This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I anointed you king over Israel, and I delivered you out of the hand of Saul. ⁸I gave you your master's house and your master's wives into your bosom, and gave you the house of Israel and of Judah; and if that would have been too little, I would have added to you many more such things. ⁹Why have you despised the LORD's word, to do that which is evil in his sight? You have struck Uriah the Hittite with the sword, have taken his wife to be your wife, and have slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon. ¹⁰Now therefore the sword will never depart from your house, because you have despised me and have taken Uriah the Hittite's wife to be your wife.' ¹¹"This is what the LORD says: 'Behold, I will raise up evil against you out of your own house; and I will take your wives before your eyes and give them to your neighbor, and he will lie with your wives in the sight of this sun. ¹²For you did this secretly, but I will do this thing before all Israel, and before the sun.'" ¹³David said to Nathan, "I have sinned

against the LORD.” Nathan said to David, “The LORD also has put away your sin. You will not die. ¹⁴However, because by this deed you have given great occasion to the LORD’s enemies to blaspheme, the child also who is born to you will surely die.” ¹⁵Then Nathan departed to his house. The LORD struck the child that Uriah’s wife bore to David, and he was very sick. ¹⁶David therefore begged God for the child; and David fasted, and went in and lay all night on the ground. ¹⁷The elders of his house arose beside him, to raise him up from the earth; but he would not, and he didn’t eat bread with them. ¹⁸On the seventh day, the child died. David’s servants were afraid to tell him that the child was dead, for they said, “Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spoke to him and he didn’t listen to our voice. How will he then harm himself if we tell him that the child is dead?” ¹⁹But when David saw that his servants were whispering together, David perceived that the child was dead; and David said to his servants, “Is the child dead?” They said, “He is dead.” ²⁰Then David arose from the earth, and washed and anointed himself, and changed his clothing; and he came into the LORD’s house, and worshiped. Then he came to his own house; and when he requested, they set bread before him and he ate. ²¹Then his servants said to him, “What is this that you have done? You fasted and wept for the child while he was alive, but when the child was dead, you rose up and ate bread.” ²²He said, “While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept; for I said, ‘Who knows whether the LORD will not be gracious to me, that the child may live?’ ²³But now he is dead. Why should I fast? Can I bring him back again? I will go to him, but he will not return to me.” ²⁴David comforted Bathsheba his wife, and went in to her, and lay with her. She bore a son, and he called his name Solomon. The LORD loved him; ²⁵and he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet, and he named him Jedidiah, ^{ix} for the LORD’s sake. ²⁶Now Joab fought against Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and took the royal city. ²⁷Joab sent messengers to David, and said, “I have fought against Rabbah. Yes, I have taken the city of waters. ²⁸Now therefore gather the rest of the people together, and encamp against the city and take it; lest I take the city, and it be called by my name.” ²⁹David gathered all the people together and went to Rabbah, and fought against it and took it. ³⁰He took the crown of their king from off his head; and its weight was a talent ^x of gold, and in it were precious stones; and it was set on David’s head. He brought a great quantity of plunder out of the city. ³¹He brought out the people who were in it, and put them to work under saws, under iron picks, under axes of iron, and made them go to the brick kiln; and he did so to all the cities of the children of Ammon. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.

¹³After this, Absalom the son of David had a beautiful sister, whose name was Tamar; and Amnon the son of David loved her. ²Amnon was so troubled that he became sick because of his sister Tamar, for she was a virgin, and it seemed hard to Amnon to do anything to her. ³But Amnon had a friend whose name was Jonadab the son of Shimeah, David’s brother; and Jonadab was a very subtle man. ⁴He said to him, “Why, son of the king, are you so sad from day to day? Won’t you tell me?” Amnon said to him, “I love Tamar, my brother Absalom’s sister.” ⁵Jonadab said to him, “Lay down on your bed and pretend to be sick. When your father comes to see you, tell him, ‘Please let my sister Tamar come and give me bread to eat, and prepare the food in my sight, that I may see it and eat it from her hand.’” ⁶So Amnon lay down and faked being sick. When the king came to see him, Amnon said to the king, “Please let my sister Tamar come and make me a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat from her hand.” ⁷Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, “Go now to your brother Amnon’s house, and prepare food for him.” ⁸So Tamar went to her brother Amnon’s house; and he was lying down. She took dough, kneaded it, made cakes in his sight, and baked the cakes. ⁹She took the pan and poured them out before him, but he refused to eat. Amnon said, “Have all men leave me.” Then every man went out from him. ¹⁰Amnon said to Tamar, “Bring the food into the room, that I may eat from your hand.” Tamar took the cakes which she had made, and brought them into the room to Amnon her brother. ¹¹When she had brought them near to him to eat, he took hold of her and said to her, “Come, lie with me, my sister!” ¹²She answered him, “No, my brother, do not force me! For no such thing ought to be done in Israel. Don’t you do this folly! ¹³As for me, where would I carry my shame? And as for you, you will be as one of the fools in Israel. Now therefore, please speak to the king; for he will not withhold me from you.” ¹⁴However, he would not listen to her voice; but being stronger than she, he forced her and lay with her. ¹⁵Then Amnon hated her with exceedingly great hatred; for the hatred with which he hated her was greater than the love with which he had loved her. Amnon said to her, “Arise, be gone!” ¹⁶She said to him, “Not so, because this great wrong in sending me away is worse than the other that you did to me!” But he would not listen to her. ¹⁷Then he called his servant who ministered to him, and said, “Now put this woman out from me, and bolt the door after her.” ¹⁸She had a garment of various colors on her, for the king’s daughters who were virgins dressed in such robes. Then his servant brought her out and bolted the door after her. ¹⁹Tamar put ashes on her head, and tore her garment of various colors that was on her; and she laid her hand on her head and went her way, crying aloud as she went. ²⁰Absalom her brother said to her, “Has Amnon your brother been with you? But now hold your peace, my sister. He is

^{ix}“Jedidiah” means “loved by Yahweh”.

^xA talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

your brother. Don't take this thing to heart." So Tamar remained desolate in her brother Absalom's house. ²¹But when King David heard of all these things, he was very angry. ²²Absalom spoke to Amnon neither good nor bad; for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar. ²³After two full years, Absalom had sheep shearers in Baal Hazor, which is beside Ephraim; and Absalom invited all the king's sons. ²⁴Absalom came to the king and said, "See now, your servant has sheep shearers. Please let the king and his servants go with your servant." ²⁵The king said to Absalom, "No, my son, let's not all go, lest we be burdensome to you." He pressed him; however he would not go, but blessed him. ²⁶Then Absalom said, "If not, please let my brother Amnon go with us." The king said to him, "Why should he go with you?" ²⁷But Absalom pressed him, and he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him. ²⁸Absalom commanded his servants, saying, "Mark now, when Amnon's heart is merry with wine; and when I tell you, 'Strike Amnon,' then kill him. Don't be afraid. Haven't I commanded you? Be courageous, and be valiant!" ²⁹The servants of Absalom did to Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and every man got up on his mule and fled. ³⁰While they were on the way, the news came to David, saying, "Absalom has slain all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left!" ³¹Then the king arose, and tore his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes torn. ³²Jonadab the son of Shimeah, David's brother, answered, "Don't let my lord suppose that they have killed all the young men, the king's sons, for Amnon only is dead; for by the appointment of Absalom this has been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar. ³³Now therefore don't let my lord the king take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king's sons are dead; for only Amnon is dead." ³⁴But Absalom fled. The young man who kept the watch lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, many people were coming by way of the hillside behind him. ³⁵Jonadab said to the king, "Behold, the king's sons are coming! It is as your servant said." ³⁶As soon as he had finished speaking, behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voices and wept. The king also and all his servants wept bitterly. ³⁷But Absalom fled and went to Talmai the son of Ammihur, king of Geshur. David mourned for his son every day. ³⁸So Absalom fled and went to Geshur, and was there three years. ³⁹King David longed to go out to Absalom, for he was comforted concerning Amnon, since he was dead.

14Now Joab the son of Zeruiah perceived that the king's heart was toward Absalom. ²Joab sent to Tekoa and brought a wise woman from there, and said to her, "Please act like a mourner, and put on mourning clothing, please, and don't anoint yourself with oil; but be as a woman who has mourned a long time for the dead. ³Go in to the king

and speak like this to him." So Joab put the words in her mouth. ⁴When the woman of Tekoa spoke to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, showed respect, and said, "Help, O king!" ⁵The king said to her, "What ails you?" She answered, "Truly I am a widow, and my husband is dead. ⁶Your servant had two sons; and they both fought together in the field, and there was no one to part them, but the one struck the other and killed him. ⁷Behold, the whole family has risen against your servant, and they say, 'Deliver him who struck his brother, that we may kill him for the life of his brother whom he killed, and so destroy the heir also.' Thus they would quench my coal which is left, and would leave to my husband neither name nor remainder on the surface of the earth." ⁸The king said to the woman, "Go to your house, and I will give a command concerning you." ⁹The woman of Tekoa said to the king, "My lord, O king, may the iniquity be on me, and on my father's house; and may the king and his throne be guiltless." ¹⁰The king said, "Whoever says anything to you, bring him to me, and he will not bother you any more." ¹¹Then she said, "Please let the king remember the LORD your God, that the avenger of blood destroy not any more, lest they destroy my son." He said, "As the LORD lives, not one hair of your son shall fall to the earth." ¹²Then the woman said, "Please let your servant speak a word to my lord the king." He said, "Say on." ¹³The woman said, "Why then have you devised such a thing against the people of God? For in speaking this word the king is as one who is guilty, in that the king does not bring home again his banished one. ¹⁴For we must die, and are like water spilled on the ground, which can't be gathered up again; neither does God take away life, but devises means, that he who is banished not be an outcast from him. ¹⁵Now therefore, seeing that I have come to speak this word to my lord the king, it is because the people have made me afraid. Your servant said, 'I will now speak to the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his servant.' ¹⁶For the king will hear, to deliver his servant out of the hand of the man who would destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of God. ¹⁷Then your servant said, 'Please let the word of my lord the king bring rest; for as an angel of God, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad. May the LORD, your God, be with you.'" ¹⁸Then the king answered the woman, "Please don't hide anything from me that I ask you." The woman said, "Let my lord the king now speak." ¹⁹The king said, "Is the hand of Joab with you in all this?" The woman answered, "As your soul lives, my lord the king, no one can turn to the right hand or to the left from anything that my lord the king has spoken; for your servant Joab urged me, and he put all these words in the mouth of your servant. ²⁰Your servant Joab has done this thing to change the face of the matter. My lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth." ²¹The king said

to Joab, "Behold now, I have granted this thing. Go therefore, and bring the young man Absalom back." ²²Joab fell to the ground on his face, showed respect, and blessed the king. Joab said, "Today your servant knows that I have found favor in your sight, my lord, O king, in that the king has performed the request of his servant." ²³So Joab arose and went to Geshur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem. ²⁴The king said, "Let him return to his own house, but let him not see my face." So Absalom returned to his own house, and didn't see the king's face. ²⁵Now in all Israel there was no one to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty. From the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no defect in him. ²⁶When he cut the hair of his head (now it was at every year's end that he cut it; because it was heavy on him, therefore he cut it), he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels, ^{xi} after the king's weight. ²⁷Three sons were born to Absalom, and one daughter, whose name was Tamar. She was a woman with a beautiful face. ²⁸Absalom lived two full years in Jerusalem, and he didn't see the king's face. ²⁹Then Absalom sent for Joab, to send him to the king, but he would not come to him. Then he sent again a second time, but he would not come. ³⁰Therefore he said to his servants, "Behold, Joab's field is near mine, and he has barley there. Go and set it on fire." So Absalom's servants set the field on fire. ³¹Then Joab arose and came to Absalom to his house, and said to him, "Why have your servants set my field on fire?" ³²Absalom answered Joab, "Behold, I sent to you, saying, 'Come here, that I may send you to the king, to say, "Why have I come from Geshur? It would be better for me to be there still. Now therefore, let me see the king's face; and if there is iniquity in me, let him kill me."'" ³³So Joab came to the king and told him; and when he had called for Absalom, he came to the king and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king; and the king kissed Absalom.

15After this, Absalom prepared a chariot and horses for himself, and fifty men to run before him. ²Absalom rose up early, and stood beside the way of the gate. When any man had a suit which should come to the king for judgment, then Absalom called to him, and said, "What city are you from?" He said, "Your servant is of one of the tribes of Israel." ³Absalom said to him, "Behold, your matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed by the king to hear you." ⁴Absalom said moreover, "Oh that I were made judge in the land, that every man who has any suit or cause might come to me, and I would do him justice!" ⁵It was so, that when any man came near to bow down to him, he stretched out his hand, took hold of him, and kissed him. ⁶Absalom did this sort of thing to all Israel who came to the king for judgment. So Absalom stole the

hearts of the men of Israel. ⁷At the end of forty years, Absalom said to the king, "Please let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed to the LORD, in Hebron. ⁸For your servant vowed a vow while I stayed at Geshur in Syria, saying, 'If the LORD shall indeed bring me again to Jerusalem, then I will serve the LORD.'" ⁹The king said to him, "Go in peace." So he arose and went to Hebron. ¹⁰But Absalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "As soon as you hear the sound of the shofar, then you shall say, 'Absalom is king in Hebron!'" ¹¹Two hundred men went with Absalom out of Jerusalem, who were invited, and went in their simplicity; and they didn't know anything. ¹²Absalom sent for Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counselor, from his city, even from Giloh, while he was offering the sacrifices. The conspiracy was strong, for the people increased continually with Absalom. ¹³A messenger came to David, saying, "The hearts of the men of Israel are after Absalom." ¹⁴David said to all his servants who were with him at Jerusalem, "Arise! Let's flee, or else none of us will escape from Absalom. Hurry to depart, lest he overtake us quickly and bring down evil on us, and strike the city with the edge of the sword." ¹⁵The king's servants said to the king, "Behold, your servants are ready to do whatever my lord the king chooses." ¹⁶The king went out, and all his household after him. The king left ten women, who were concubines, to keep the house. ¹⁷The king went out, and all the people after him; and they stayed in Beth Merhah. ¹⁸All his servants passed on beside him; and all the Cherethites, and all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites, six hundred men who came after him from Gath, passed on before the king. ¹⁹Then the king said to Ittai the Gittite, "Why do you also go with us? Return, and stay with the king; for you are a foreigner and also an exile. Return to your own place. ²⁰Whereas you came but yesterday, should I today make you go up and down with us, since I go where I may? Return, and take back your brothers. Mercy and truth be with you." ²¹Ittai answered the king and said, "As the LORD lives, and as my lord the king lives, surely in what place my lord the king is, whether for death or for life, your servant will be there also." ²²David said to Ittai, "Go and pass over." Ittai the Gittite passed over, and all his men, and all the little ones who were with him. ²³All the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over. The king also himself passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over toward the way of the wilderness. ²⁴Behold, Zadok also came, and all the Levites with him, bearing the ark of the covenant of God; and they set down God's ark; and Abiathar went up until all the people finished passing out of the city. ²⁵The king said to Zadok, "Carry God's ark back into the city. If I find favor in the LORD's eyes, he will bring me again, and show me both it and his habitation; ²⁶but if he says, 'I have no delight in you,' behold, here I am. Let him do to me as seems good to him." ²⁷The king said also to Zadok

^{xi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 200 shekels is about 2 kilograms or about 4.4 pounds.

the priest, "Aren't you a seer? Return into the city in peace, and your two sons with you, Ahimaaz your son and Jonathan the son of Abiathar. ²⁸Behold, I will stay at the fords of the wilderness until word comes from you to inform me." ²⁹Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried God's ark to Jerusalem again; and they stayed there. ³⁰David went up by the ascent of the Mount of Olives, and wept as he went up; and he had his head covered and went barefoot. All the people who were with him each covered his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up. ³¹Someone told David, saying, "Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom." David said, "LORD, please turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness." ³²When David had come to the top, where God was worshiped, behold, Hushai the Archite came to meet him with his tunic torn and earth on his head. ³³David said to him, "If you pass on with me, then you will be a burden to me; ³⁴but if you return to the city, and tell Absalom, 'I will be your servant, O king. As I have been your father's servant in time past, so I will now be your servant; then will you defeat for me the counsel of Ahithophel.' ³⁵Don't you have Zadok and Abiathar the priests there with you? Therefore whatever you hear out of the king's house, tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests. ³⁶Behold, they have there with them their two sons, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and Jonathan, Abiathar's son. Send to me everything that you shall hear by them." ³⁷So Hushai, David's friend, came into the city; and Absalom came into Jerusalem.

16When David was a little past the top, behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him with a couple of donkeys saddled, and on them two hundred loaves of bread, and one hundred clusters of raisins, and one hundred summer fruits, and a container of wine. ²The king said to Ziba, "What do you mean by these?" Ziba said, "The donkeys are for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that those who are faint in the wilderness may drink." ³The king said, "Where is your master's son?" Ziba said to the king, "Behold, he is staying in Jerusalem; for he said, 'Today the house of Israel will restore me the kingdom of my father.'" ⁴Then the king said to Ziba, "Behold, all that belongs to Mephibosheth is yours." Ziba said, "I bow down. Let me find favor in your sight, my lord, O king." ⁵When King David came to Bahurim, behold, a man of the family of Saul's house came out, whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera. He came out and cursed as he came. ⁶He cast stones at David and at all the servants of King David, and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left. ⁷Shimei said when he cursed, "Be gone, be gone, you man of blood, and wicked fellow! ⁸The LORD has returned on you all the blood of Saul's house, in whose place you have reigned! The LORD has delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom your son!

Behold, you are caught by your own mischief, because you are a man of blood!" ⁹Then Abishai the son of Zeruiah said to the king, "Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? Please let me go over and take off his head." ¹⁰The king said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah? Because he curses, and because the LORD has said to him, 'Curse David,' who then shall say, 'Why have you done so?'" ¹¹David said to Abishai and to all his servants, "Behold, my son, who came out of my bowels, seeks my life. How much more this Benjamite, now? Leave him alone, and let him curse; for the LORD has invited him. ¹²It may be that the LORD will look on the wrong done to me, and that the LORD will repay me good for the cursing of me today." ¹³So David and his men went by the way; and Shimei went along on the hillside opposite him and cursed as he went, threw stones at him, and threw dust. ¹⁴The king and all the people who were with him arrived weary; and he refreshed himself there. ¹⁵Absalom and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him. ¹⁶When Hushai the Archite, David's friend, had come to Absalom, Hushai said to Absalom, "Long live the king! Long live the king!" ¹⁷Absalom said to Hushai, "Is this your kindness to your friend? Why didn't you go with your friend?" ¹⁸Hushai said to Absalom, "No; but whomever the LORD and this people and all the men of Israel have chosen, I will be his, and I will stay with him. ¹⁹Again, whom should I serve? Shouldn't I serve in the presence of his son? As I have served in your father's presence, so I will be in your presence." ²⁰Then Absalom said to Ahithophel, "Give your counsel what we shall do." ²¹Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Go in to your father's concubines that he has left to keep the house. Then all Israel will hear that you are abhorred by your father. Then the hands of all who are with you will be strong." ²²So they spread a tent for Absalom on the top of the house, and Absalom went in to his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel. ²³The counsel of Ahithophel, which he gave in those days, was as if a man inquired at the inner sanctuary of God. All the counsel of Ahithophel was like this both with David and with Absalom.

17Moreover Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Let me now choose twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David tonight. ²I will come on him while he is weary and exhausted, and will make him afraid. All the people who are with him will flee. I will strike the king only, ³and I will bring back all the people to you. The man whom you seek is as if all returned. All the people shall be in peace." ⁴The saying pleased Absalom well, and all the elders of Israel. ⁵Then Absalom said, "Now call Hushai the Archite also, and let's hear likewise what he says." ⁶When Hushai had come to Absalom, Absalom spoke to him, saying, "Ahithophel has spoken like this. Shall we do what he says? If not, speak up." ⁷Hushai said to Absalom, "The

counsel that Ahithophel has given this time is not good.”⁸Hushai said moreover, “You know your father and his men, that they are mighty men, and they are fierce in their minds, like a bear robbed of her cubs in the field. Your father is a man of war, and will not lodge with the people.⁹Behold, he is now hidden in some pit, or in some other place. It will happen, when some of them have fallen at the first, that whoever hears it will say, ‘There is a slaughter among the people who follow Absalom!’¹⁰Even he who is valiant, whose heart is as the heart of a lion, will utterly melt; for all Israel knows that your father is a mighty man, and those who are with him are valiant men.¹¹But I counsel that all Israel be gathered together to you, from Dan even to Beersheba, as the sand that is by the sea for multitude; and that you go to battle in your own person.¹²So we will come on him in some place where he will be found, and we will light on him as the dew falls on the ground, then we will not leave so much as one of him and of all the men who are with him.¹³Moreover, if he has gone into a city, then all Israel will bring ropes to that city, and we will draw it into the river, until there isn’t one small stone found there.”¹⁴Absalom and all the men of Israel said, “The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better than the counsel of Ahithophel.” For the LORD had ordained to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent that the LORD might bring evil on Absalom.¹⁵Then Hushai said to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, “Ahithophel counseled Absalom and the elders of Israel that way; and I have counseled this way.¹⁶Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying, ‘Don’t lodge tonight at the fords of the wilderness, but by all means pass over, lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people who are with him.’”¹⁷Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz were staying by En Rogel; and a female servant used to go and report to them, and they went and told King David; for they couldn’t risk being seen coming into the city.¹⁸But a boy saw them, and told Absalom. Then they both went away quickly and came to the house of a man in Bahurim, who had a well in his court; and they went down there.¹⁹The woman took and spread the covering over the well’s mouth, and spread out crushed grain on it; and nothing was known.²⁰Absalom’s servants came to the woman to the house; and they said, “Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan?” The woman said to them, “They have gone over the brook of water.” When they had sought and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.²¹After they had departed, they came up out of the well and went and told King David; and they said to David, “Arise and pass quickly over the water; for thus has Ahithophel counseled against you.”²²Then David arose, and all the people who were with him, and they passed over the Jordan. By the morning light there lacked not one of them who had not gone over the Jordan.²³When Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his donkey, arose, and went home to his city, set his

house in order, and hanged himself; and he died, and was buried in the tomb of his father.²⁴Then David came to Mahanaim. Absalom passed over the Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him.²⁵Absalom set Amasa over the army instead of Joab. Now Amasa was the son of a man whose name was Ithra the Israelite, who went in to Abigail the daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruiah, Joab’s mother.²⁶Israel and Absalom encamped in the land of Gilead.²⁷When David had come to Mahanaim, Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim,²⁸brought beds, basins, earthen vessels, wheat, barley, meal, parched grain, beans, lentils, roasted grain,²⁹honey, butter, sheep, and cheese of the herd, for David and for the people who were with him to eat; for they said, “The people are hungry, weary, and thirsty in the wilderness.”

¹⁸David counted the people who were with him, and set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them.²David sent the people out, a third part under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab’s brother, and a third part under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. The king said to the people, “I will also surely go out with you myself.”³But the people said, “You shall not go out, for if we flee away, they will not care for us, neither if half of us die, will they care for us. But you are worth ten thousand of us. Therefore now it is better that you are ready to help us out of the city.”⁴The king said to them, “I will do what seems best to you.” The king stood beside the gate, and all the people went out by hundreds and by thousands.⁵The king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, “Deal gently for my sake with the young man Absalom.” All the people heard when the king commanded all the captains concerning Absalom.⁶So the people went out into the field against Israel; and the battle was in the forest of Ephraim.⁷The people of Israel were struck there before David’s servants, and there was a great slaughter there that day of twenty thousand men.⁸For the battle was there spread over the surface of all the country, and the forest devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.⁹Absalom happened to meet David’s servants. Absalom was riding on his mule, and the mule went under the thick boughs of a great oak; and his head caught hold of the oak, and he was hanging between the sky and earth; and the mule that was under him went on.¹⁰A certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, “Behold, I saw Absalom hanging in an oak.”¹¹Joab said to the man who told him, “Behold, you saw it, and why didn’t you strike him there to the ground? I would have given you ten pieces of silver and a sash.”¹²The man said to Joab, “Though I should receive a thousand pieces of silver in my hand, I still wouldn’t stretch out my hand against the king’s son; for in our hearing the king com-

manded you and Abishai and Ittai, saying, 'Beware that no one touch the young man Absalom.' ¹³Otherwise, if I had dealt falsely against his life (and there is no matter hidden from the king), then you yourself would have set yourself against me." ¹⁴Then Joab said, "I'm not going to wait like this with you." He took three darts in his hand and thrust them through Absalom's heart while he was still alive in the middle of the oak. ¹⁵Ten young men who bore Joab's armor surrounded and struck Absalom, and killed him. ¹⁶Joab blew the shofar, and the people returned from pursuing after Israel; for Joab held the people back. ¹⁷They took Absalom and cast him into a great pit in the forest, and raised over him a very great heap of stones. Then all Israel fled, each to his own tent. ¹⁸Now Absalom in his lifetime had taken and reared up for himself the pillar which is in the king's valley, for he said, "I have no son to keep my name in memory." He called the pillar after his own name. It is called Absalom's monument, to this day. ¹⁹Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said, "Let me now run and carry the king news, how the LORD has avenged him of his enemies." ²⁰Joab said to him, "You must not be the bearer of news today, but you must carry news another day. But today you must carry no news, because the king's son is dead." ²¹Then Joab said to the Cushite, "Go, tell the king what you have seen!" The Cushite bowed himself to Joab, and ran. ²²Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said yet again to Joab, "But come what may, please let me also run after the Cushite." Joab said, "Why do you want to run, my son, since you will have no reward for the news?" ²³"But come what may," he said, "I will run." He said to him, "Run!" Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the Plain, and outran the Cushite. ²⁴Now David was sitting between the two gates; and the watchman went up to the roof of the gate to the wall, and lifted up his eyes and looked, and, behold, a man running alone. ²⁵The watchman shouted and told the king. The king said, "If he is alone, there is news in his mouth." He came closer and closer. ²⁶The watchman saw another man running; and the watchman called to the gatekeeper and said, "Behold, a man running alone!" The king said, "He also brings news." ²⁷The watchman said, "I think the running of the first one is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok." The king said, "He is a good man, and comes with good news." ²⁸Ahimaaz called, and said to the king, "All is well." He bowed himself before the king with his face to the earth, and said, "Blessed is the LORD your God, who has delivered up the men who lifted up their hand against my lord the king!" ²⁹The king said, "Is it well with the young man Absalom?" Ahimaaz answered, "When Joab sent the king's servant, even me your servant, I saw a great tumult, but I don't know what it was." ³⁰The king said, "Come and stand here." He came and stood still. ³¹Behold, the Cushite came. The Cushite said, "Good news for my lord the king, for the LORD has avenged you today of all

those who rose up against you." ³²The king said to the Cushite, "Is it well with the young man Absalom?" The Cushite answered, "May the enemies of my lord the king, and all who rise up against you to do you harm, be as that young man is." ³³The king was much moved, and went up to the room over the gate and wept. As he went, he said, "My son Absalom! My son, my son Absalom! I wish I had died instead of you, Absalom, my son, my son!"

19Joab was told, "Behold, the king weeps and mourns for Absalom." ²The victory that day was turned into mourning among all the people, for the people heard it said that day, "The king grieves for his son." ³The people sneaked into the city that day, as people who are ashamed steal away when they flee in battle. ⁴The king covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, "My son Absalom, Absalom, my son, my son!" ⁵Joab came into the house to the king, and said, "Today you have shamed the faces of all your servants who today have saved your life, and the lives of your sons and of your daughters, and the lives of your wives, and the lives of your concubines; ⁶in that you love those who hate you and hate those who love you. For you have declared today that princes and servants are nothing to you. For today I perceive that if Absalom had lived and we had all died today, then it would have pleased you well. ⁷Now therefore arise, go out and speak to comfort your servants; for I swear by the LORD, if you don't go out, not a man will stay with you this night. That would be worse to you than all the evil that has happened to you from your youth until now." ⁸Then the king arose and sat in the gate. The people were all told, "Behold, the king is sitting in the gate." All the people came before the king. Now Israel had fled every man to his tent. ⁹All the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "The king delivered us out of the hand of our enemies, and he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now he has fled out of the land from Absalom. ¹⁰Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why don't you speak a word of bringing the king back?" ¹¹King David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, "Speak to the elders of Judah, saying, 'Why are you the last to bring the king back to his house, since the speech of all Israel has come to the king, to return him to his house? ¹²You are my brothers. You are my bone and my flesh. Why then are you the last to bring back the king?' ¹³Say to Amasa, 'Aren't you my bone and my flesh? God do so to me, and more also, if you aren't captain of the army before me continually instead of Joab.'" ¹⁴He bowed the heart of all the men of Judah, even as one man, so that they sent to the king, saying, "Return, you and all your servants." ¹⁵So the king returned, and came to the Jordan. Judah came to Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to bring the king over the Jordan. ¹⁶Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite,

who was of Bahurim, hurried and came down with the men of Judah to meet King David. ¹⁷There were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of Saul's house, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went through the Jordan in the presence of the king. ¹⁸A ferry boat went to bring over the king's household, and to do what he thought good. Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king when he had come over the Jordan. ¹⁹He said to the king, "Don't let my lord impute iniquity to me, or remember that which your servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart. ²⁰For your servant knows that I have sinned. Therefore behold, I have come today as the first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king." ²¹But Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered, "Shouldn't Shimei be put to death for this, because he cursed the LORD's anointed?" ²²David said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah, that you should be adversaries to me today? Shall any man be put to death today in Israel? For don't I know that I am king over Israel today?" ²³The king said to Shimei, "You will not die." The king swore to him. ²⁴Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king; and he had neither groomed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came home in peace. ²⁵When he had come to Jerusalem to meet the king, the king said to him, "Why didn't you go with me, Mephibosheth?" ²⁶He answered, "My lord, O king, my servant deceived me. For your servant said, 'I will saddle a donkey for myself, that I may ride on it and go with the king,' because your servant is lame. ²⁷He has slandered your servant to my lord the king, but my lord the king is as an angel of God. Therefore do what is good in your eyes. ²⁸For all my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king; yet you set your servant among those who ate at your own table. What right therefore have I yet that I should appeal any more to the king?" ²⁹The king said to him, "Why do you speak any more of your matters? I say, you and Ziba divide the land." ³⁰Mephibosheth said to the king, "Yes, let him take all, because my lord the king has come in peace to his own house." ³¹Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim; and he went over the Jordan with the king to conduct him over the Jordan. ³²Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even eighty years old. He had provided the king with sustenance while he stayed at Mahanaim, for he was a very great man. ³³The king said to Barzillai, "Come over with me, and I will sustain you with me in Jerusalem." ³⁴Barzillai said to the king, "How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem? ³⁵I am eighty years old, today. Can I discern between good and bad? Can your servant taste what I eat or what I drink? Can I hear the voice of singing men and singing women any more? Why then should your

servant be a burden to my lord the king?" ³⁶Your servant will just go over the Jordan with the king. Why should the king repay me with such a reward? ³⁷Please let your servant turn back again, that I may die in my own city, by the grave of my father and my mother. But behold, your servant Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good to you." ³⁸The king answered, "Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good to you. Whatever you request of me, that I will do for you." ³⁹All the people went over the Jordan, and the king went over. Then the king kissed Barzillai and blessed him; and he returned to his own place. ⁴⁰So the king went over to Gilgal, and Chimham went over with him. All the people of Judah brought the king over, and also half the people of Israel. ⁴¹Behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said to the king, "Why have our brothers the men of Judah stolen you away, and brought the king and his household, over the Jordan, and all David's men with him?" ⁴²All the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, "Because the king is a close relative to us. Why then are you angry about this matter? Have we eaten at all at the king's cost? Or has he given us any gift?" ⁴³The men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, "We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more claim to David than you. Why then did you despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king?" The words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

20There happened to be there a wicked fellow, whose name was Sheba the son of Bichri, a Benjamite; and he blew the shofar, and said, "We have no portion in David, neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse. Every man to his tents, Israel!" ²So all the men of Israel went up from following David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri; but the men of Judah joined with their king, from the Jordan even to Jerusalem. ³David came to his house at Jerusalem; and the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in custody and provided them with sustenance, but didn't go in to them. So they were shut up to the day of their death, living in widowhood. ⁴Then the king said to Amasa, "Call me the men of Judah together within three days, and be here present." ⁵So Amasa went to call the men of Judah together, but he stayed longer than the set time which had been appointed to him. ⁶David said to Abishai, "Now Sheba the son of Bichri will do us more harm than Absalom did. Take your lord's servants and pursue after him, lest he get himself fortified cities, and escape out of our sight." ⁷Joab's men went out after him with the Cherethites, the Pelethites, and all the mighty men; and they went out of Jerusalem to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri. ⁸When they were at the great stone which is in Gibeon, Amasa came

to meet them. Joab was clothed in his apparel of war that he had put on, and on it was a sash with a sword fastened on his waist in its sheath; and as he went along it fell out. ⁹Joab said to Amasa, "Is it well with you, my brother?" Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him. ¹⁰But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand. So he struck him with it in the body and shed out his bowels to the ground, and didn't strike him again; and he died. Joab and Abishai his brother pursued Sheba the son of Bichri. ¹¹One of Joab's young men stood by him, and said, "He who favors Joab, and he who is for David, let him follow Joab!" ¹²Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the middle of the highway. When the man saw that all the people stood still, he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a garment over him when he saw that everyone who came by him stood still. ¹³When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri. ¹⁴He went through all the tribes of Israel to Abel, to Beth Maacah, and all the Berites. They were gathered together, and went also after him. ¹⁵They came and besieged him in Abel of Beth Maacah, and they cast up a mound against the city, and it stood against the rampart; and all the people who were with Joab battered the wall to throw it down. ¹⁶Then a wise woman cried out of the city, "Hear, hear! Please say to Joab, 'Come near here, that I may speak with you.'" ¹⁷He came near to her; and the woman said, "Are you Joab?" He answered, "I am." Then she said to him, "Hear the words of your servant." He answered, "I'm listening." ¹⁸Then she spoke, saying, "They used to say in old times, 'They shall surely ask counsel at Abel,' and so they settled a matter. ¹⁹I am among those who are peaceable and faithful in Israel. You seek to destroy a city and a mother in Israel. Why will you swallow up the LORD's inheritance?" ²⁰Joab answered, "Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy. ²¹The matter is not so. But a man of the hill country of Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri by name, has lifted up his hand against the king, even against David. Just deliver him, and I will depart from the city." The woman said to Joab, "Behold, his head will be thrown to you over the wall." ²²Then the woman went to all the people in her wisdom. They cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and threw it out to Joab. He blew the shofar, and they were dispersed from the city, every man to his tent. Then Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king. ²³Now Joab was over all the army of Israel, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites, ²⁴Adoram was over the men subject to forced labor, Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was the recorder, ²⁵Sheva was scribe, Zadok and Abiathar were priests, ²⁶and Ira the Jairite was chief minister to David.

²¹There was a famine in the days of David for three

years, year after year; and David sought the face of the LORD. The LORD said, "It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he put the Gibeonites to death." ²The king called the Gibeonites and said to them (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites, and the children of Israel had sworn to them; and Saul sought to kill them in his zeal for the children of Israel and Judah); ³and David said to the Gibeonites, "What should I do for you? And with what should I make atonement, that you may bless the LORD's inheritance?" ⁴The Gibeonites said to him, "It is no matter of silver or gold between us and Saul or his house; neither is it for us to put any man to death in Israel." He said, "I will do for you whatever you say." ⁵They said to the king, "The man who consumed us and who plotted against us, that we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the borders of Israel, ⁶let seven men of his sons be delivered to us, and we will hang them up to the LORD in Gibeah of Saul, the chosen of the LORD." The king said, "I will give them." ⁷But the king spared Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the LORD's oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul. ⁸But the king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bore to Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth; and the five sons of Merab the daughter of Saul, whom she bore to Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholahite. ⁹He delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites; and they hanged them on the mountain before the LORD, and all seven of them fell together. They were put to death in the days of harvest, in the first days, at the beginning of barley harvest. ¹⁰Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth and spread it for herself on the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water poured on them from the sky. She allowed neither the birds of the sky to rest on them by day, nor the animals of the field by night. ¹¹David was told what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done. ¹²So David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabesh Gilead, who had stolen them from the street of Beth Shan, where the Philistines had hanged them in the day that the Philistines killed Saul in Gilboa; ¹³and he brought up from there the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son. They also gathered the bones of those who were hanged. ¹⁴They buried the bones of Saul and Jonathan his son in the country of Benjamin in Zela, in the tomb of Kish his father; and they performed all that the king commanded. After that, God answered prayer for the land. ¹⁵The Philistines had war again with Israel; and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines. David grew faint; ¹⁶and Ishbubenob, who was of the sons of the giant, the weight of whose spear was three hundred shekels of bronze in weight, he being armed with a new sword, thought he would kill David. ¹⁷But Abishai the son of Zeruiah helped him, and

struck the Philistine and killed him. Then the men of David swore to him, saying, "Don't go out with us to battle any more, so that you don't quench the lamp of Israel."¹⁸After this, there was again war with the Philistines at Gob. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Saph, who was of the sons of the giant.¹⁹There was again war with the Philistines at Gob, and Elhanan the son of Jaare-Oregim the Bethlehemite killed Goliath the Gittite's brother, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.²⁰There was again war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, who had six fingers on every hand and six toes on every foot, twenty-four in number, and he also was born to the giant.²¹When he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimei, David's brother, killed him.²²These four were born to the giant in Gath; and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

22David spoke to the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul,²and he said: "The LORD is my rock, my fortress, and my deliverer, even mine;³God is my rock in whom I take refuge; my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge. My savior, you save me from violence.⁴I call on the LORD, who is worthy to be praised; So shall I be saved from my enemies.⁵For the waves of death surrounded me. The floods of ungodliness made me afraid.⁶The cords of Sheol^{xii} were around me. The snares of death caught me.⁷In my distress, I called on the LORD. Yes, I called to my God. He heard my voice out of his temple. My cry came into his ears.⁸Then the earth shook and trembled. The foundations of heaven quaked and were shaken, because he was angry.⁹Smoke went up out of his nostrils. Consuming fire came out of his mouth. Coals were kindled by it.¹⁰He bowed the heavens also, and came down. Thick darkness was under his feet.¹¹He rode on a cherub, and flew. Yes, he was seen on the wings of the wind.¹²He made darkness a shelter around himself, gathering of waters, and thick clouds of the skies.¹³At the brightness before him, coals of fire were kindled.¹⁴The LORD thundered from heaven. The Most High uttered his voice.¹⁵He sent out arrows and scattered them, lightning and confused them.¹⁶Then the channels of the sea appeared. The foundations of the world were laid bare by the LORD's rebuke, at the blast of the breath of his nostrils.¹⁷He sent from on high and he took me. He drew me out of many waters.¹⁸He delivered me from my strong enemy, from those who hated me, for they were too mighty for me.¹⁹They came on me in the day of my calamity, but the LORD was my support.²⁰He also brought me out into a large place. He delivered me, because he delighted in me.²¹The LORD rewarded me according to my righteousness. He rewarded me according to the cleanness of my hands.²²For I have kept the

LORD's ways, and have not wickedly departed from my God.²³For all his ordinances were before me. As for his statutes, I didn't depart from them.²⁴I was also perfect toward him. I kept myself from my iniquity.²⁵Therefore the LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, According to my cleanness in his eyesight.²⁶With the merciful you will show yourself merciful. With the perfect man you will show yourself perfect.²⁷With the pure you will show yourself pure. With the crooked you will show yourself shrewd.²⁸You will save the afflicted people, but your eyes are on the arrogant, that you may bring them down.²⁹For you are my lamp, LORD. The LORD will light up my darkness.³⁰For by you, I run against a troop. By my God, I leap over a wall.³¹As for God, his way is perfect. The LORD's word is tested. He is a shield to all those who take refuge in him.³²For who is God, besides the LORD? Who is a rock, besides our God?³³God is my strong fortress. He makes my way perfect.³⁴He makes his feet like hinds' feet, and sets me on my high places.³⁵He teaches my hands to war, so that my arms bend a bow of bronze.³⁶You have also given me the shield of your salvation. Your gentleness has made me great.³⁷You have enlarged my steps under me. My feet have not slipped.³⁸I have pursued my enemies and destroyed them. I didn't turn again until they were consumed.³⁹I have consumed them, and struck them through, so that they can't arise. Yes, they have fallen under my feet.⁴⁰For you have armed me with strength for the battle. You have subdued under me those who rose up against me.⁴¹You have also made my enemies turn their backs to me, that I might cut off those who hate me.⁴²They looked, but there was no one to save; even to the LORD, but he didn't answer them.⁴³Then I beat them as small as the dust of the earth. I crushed them as the mire of the streets, and spread them abroad.⁴⁴You also have delivered me from the strivings of my people. You have kept me to be the head of the nations. A people whom I have not known will serve me.⁴⁵The foreigners will submit themselves to me. As soon as they hear of me, they will obey me.⁴⁶The foreigners will fade away, and will come trembling out of their close places.⁴⁷The LORD lives! Blessed be my rock! Exalted be God, the rock of my salvation,⁴⁸even the God who executes vengeance for me, who brings down peoples under me,⁴⁹who brings me away from my enemies. Yes, you lift me up above those who rise up against me. You deliver me from the violent man.⁵⁰Therefore I will give thanks to you, LORD, among the nations, and will sing praises to your name.⁵¹He gives great deliverance to his king, and shows loving kindness to his anointed, to David and to his offspring, forever more."

23Now these are the last words of David. David the son of Jesse says, the man who was raised on high says, the anointed of the God of Jacob, the sweet psalmist of

^{xii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

Israel: ²“The LORD’s Spirit spoke by me. His word was on my tongue. ³The God of Israel said, the Rock of Israel spoke to me, ‘One who rules over men righteously, who rules in the fear of God, ⁴shall be as the light of the morning when the sun rises, a morning without clouds, when the tender grass springs out of the earth, through clear shining after rain.’ ⁵Isn’t my house so with God? Yet he has made with me an everlasting covenant, ordered in all things, and sure, for it is all my salvation and all my desire. Won’t he make it grow? ⁶But all the ungodly will be as thorns to be thrust away, because they can’t be taken with the hand. ⁷The man who touches them must be armed with iron and the staff of a spear. They will be utterly burned with fire in their place.” ⁸These are the names of the mighty men whom David had: Josheb Basshebeth a Tahchemonite, chief of the captains; he was called Adino the Eznite, who killed eight hundred at one time. ⁹After him was Eleazar the son of Dodai the son of an Ahohite, one of the three mighty men with David when they defied the Philistines who were there gathered together to battle, and the men of Israel had gone away. ¹⁰He arose and struck the Philistines until his hand was weary, and his hand froze to the sword; and the LORD worked a great victory that day; and the people returned after him only to take plunder. ¹¹After him was Shammah the son of Agee a Hararite. The Philistines had gathered together into a troop where there was a plot of ground full of lentils; and the people fled from the Philistines. ¹²But he stood in the middle of the plot and defended it, and killed the Philistines; and the LORD worked a great victory. ¹³Three of the thirty chief men went down, and came to David in the harvest time to the cave of Adullam; and the troop of the Philistines was encamped in the valley of Rephaim. ¹⁴David was then in the stronghold; and the garrison of the Philistines was then in Bethlehem. ¹⁵David said longingly, “Oh that someone would give me water to drink from the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate!” ¹⁶The three mighty men broke through the army of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem that was by the gate and took it and brought it to David; but he would not drink of it, but poured it out to the LORD. ¹⁷He said, “Be it far from me, LORD, that I should do this! Isn’t this the blood of the men who risked their lives to go?” Therefore he would not drink it. The three mighty men did these things. ¹⁸Abishai, the brother of Joab, the son of Zeruiah, was chief of the three. He lifted up his spear against three hundred and killed them, and had a name among the three. ¹⁹Wasn’t he most honorable of the three? Therefore he was made their captain. However he wasn’t included as one of the three. ²⁰Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done mighty deeds, killed the two sons of Ariel of Moab. He also went down and killed a lion in the middle of a pit in a time of snow. ²¹He killed a huge Egyptian, and the Egyptian had a spear

in his hand; but he went down to him with a staff and plucked the spear out of the Egyptian’s hand, and killed him with his own spear. ²²Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did these things, and had a name among the three mighty men. ²³He was more honorable than the thirty, but he didn’t attain to the three. David set him over his guard. ²⁴Asahel the brother of Joab was one of the thirty: Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem, ²⁵Shammah the Harodite, Elikah the Harodite, ²⁶Helez the Paltite, Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, ²⁷Abiezer the Anathothite, Mebunnai the Hushathite, ²⁸Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite, ²⁹Heleb the son of Baanah the Netophathite, Ittai the son of Ribai of Gibeath of the children of Benjamin, ³⁰Benaiah a Pirathonite, Hiddai of the brooks of Gaash. ³¹Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth the Barhumite, ³²Eliabha the Shaalbonite, the sons of Jashen, Jonathan, ³³Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam the son of Sharar the Ararite, ³⁴Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai, the son of the Maacathite, Eliam the son of Ahithophel the Gilonite, ³⁵Hezro the Carmelite, Paarai the Arbite, ³⁶Igal the son of Nathan of Zobah, Bani the Gadite, ³⁷Zehek the Ammonite, Naharai the Beerothite, armor bearers to Joab the son of Zeruiah, ³⁸Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite, ³⁹and Uriah the Hittite: thirty-seven in all.

24Again the LORD’s anger burned against Israel, and he moved David against them, saying, “Go, count Israel and Judah.” ²The king said to Joab the captain of the army, who was with him, “Now go back and forth through all the tribes of Israel, from Dan even to Beersheba, and count the people, that I may know the sum of the people.” ³Joab said to the king, “Now may the LORD your God add to the people, however many they may be, one hundred times; and may the eyes of my lord the king see it. But why does my lord the king delight in this thing?” ⁴Notwithstanding, the king’s word prevailed against Joab and against the captains of the army. Joab and the captains of the army went out from the presence of the king to count the people of Israel. ⁵They passed over the Jordan and encamped in Aroer, on the right side of the city that is in the middle of the valley of Gad, and to Jazer; ⁶then they came to Gilead and to the land of Tahtim Hodshi; and they came to Dan Jaan and around to Sidon, ⁷and came to the stronghold of Tyre, and to all the cities of the Hivites and of the Canaanites; and they went out to the south of Judah, at Beersheba. ⁸So when they had gone back and forth through all the land, they came to Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days. ⁹Joab gave up the sum of the counting of the people to the king; and there were in Israel eight hundred thousand valiant men who drew the sword, and the men of Judah were five hundred thousand men. ¹⁰David’s heart struck him after he had counted the people. David said to the LORD, “I have sinned greatly in that which I have done. But now, the LORD, put away,

I beg you, the iniquity of your servant; for I have done very foolishly.” ¹¹When David rose up in the morning, the LORD’s word came to the prophet Gad, David’s seer, saying, ¹²“Go and speak to David, ‘The LORD says, “I offer you three things. Choose one of them, that I may do it to you.”’” ¹³So Gad came to David, and told him, saying, “Shall seven years of famine come to you in your land? Or will you flee three months before your foes while they pursue you? Or shall there be three days’ pestilence in your land? Now answer, and consider what answer I shall return to him who sent me.” ¹⁴David said to Gad, “I am in distress. Let us fall now into the LORD’s hand, for his mercies are great. Let me not fall into man’s hand.” ¹⁵So the LORD sent a pestilence on Israel from the morning even to the appointed time; and seventy thousand men died of the people from Dan even to Beersheba. ¹⁶When the angel stretched out his hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it, the LORD relented of the disaster, and said to the angel who destroyed the people, “It is enough. Now withdraw your hand.” The LORD’s angel was by the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite. ¹⁷David spoke to the LORD when he saw the angel who struck the people, and said, “Behold, I have sinned, and I have done perversely; but these sheep, what have they done? Please let your hand be against me, and against my father’s house.” ¹⁸Gad came that day to David and said to him, “Go up, build an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Araunah the Jebusite.” ¹⁹David went up according to the saying of Gad, as the LORD commanded. ²⁰Araunah looked out, and saw the king and his servants coming on toward him. Then Araunah went out and bowed himself before the king with his face to the ground. ²¹Araunah said, “Why has my lord the king come to his servant?” David said, “To buy your threshing floor, to build an altar to the LORD, that the plague may be stopped from afflicting the people.” ²²Araunah said to David, “Let my lord the king take and offer up what seems good to him. Behold, the cattle for the burnt offering, and the threshing sledges and the yokes of the oxen for the wood.” ²³All this, O king, does Araunah give to the king.” Araunah said to the king, “May the LORD your God accept you.” ²⁴The king said to Araunah, “No, but I will most certainly buy it from you for a price. I will not offer burnt offerings to the LORD my God which cost me nothing.” So David bought the threshing floor and the oxen for fifty shekels ^{xiii} of silver. ²⁵David built an altar to the LORD there, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. So the LORD was entreated for the land, and the plague was removed from Israel.

^{xiii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 50 shekels is about 0.5 kilograms or 1.1 pounds.

1 Kings

¹Now King David was old and advanced in years; and they covered him with clothes, but he couldn't keep warm. ²Therefore his servants said to him, "Let a young virgin be sought for my lord the king. Let her stand before the king, and cherish him; and let her lie in your bosom, that my lord the king may keep warm." ³So they sought for a beautiful young lady throughout all the borders of Israel, and found Abishag the Shunammite, and brought her to the king. ⁴The young lady was very beautiful; and she cherished the king, and served him; but the king didn't know her intimately. ⁵Then Adonijah the son of Haggith exalted himself, saying, "I will be king." Then he prepared him chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him. ⁶His father had not displeased him at any time in saying, "Why have you done so?" and he was also a very handsome man; and he was born after Absalom. ⁷He conferred with Joab the son of Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest; and they followed Adonijah and helped him. ⁸But Zadok the priest, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, Nathan the prophet, Shimei, Rei, and the mighty men who belonged to David, were not with Adonijah. ⁹Adonijah killed sheep, cattle, and fatlings by the stone of Zoheleth, which is beside En Rogel; and he called all his brothers, the king's sons, and all the men of Judah, the king's servants; ¹⁰but he didn't call Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah, and the mighty men, and Solomon his brother. ¹¹Then Nathan spoke to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon, saying, "Haven't you heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith reigns, and David our lord doesn't know it? ¹²Now therefore come, please let me give you counsel, that you may save your own life and your son Solomon's life. ¹³Go in to King David, and tell him, 'Didn't you, my lord the king, swear to your servant, saying, 'Assuredly Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne?' Why then does Adonijah reign?' ¹⁴Behold, ⁱ while you are still talking there with the king, I will also come in after you and confirm your words." ¹⁵Bathsheba went in to the king in his room. The king was very old; and Abishag the Shunammite was serving the king. ¹⁶Bathsheba bowed and showed respect to the king. The king said, "What would you like?" ¹⁷She

said to him, "My lord, you swore by the LORD ⁱⁱ your God ⁱⁱⁱ to your servant, 'Assuredly Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne.' ¹⁸Now, behold, Adonijah reigns; and you, my lord the king, don't know it. ¹⁹He has slain cattle and fatlings and sheep in abundance, and has called all the sons of the king, Abiathar the priest, and Joab the captain of the army; but he hasn't called Solomon your servant. ²⁰You, my lord the king, the eyes of all Israel are on you, that you should tell them who will sit on the throne of my lord the king after him. ²¹Otherwise it will happen, when my lord the king sleeps with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon will be considered criminals." ²²Behold, while she was still talking with the king, Nathan the prophet came in. ²³They told the king, saying, "Behold, Nathan the prophet!" When he had come in before the king, he bowed himself before the king with his face to the ground. ²⁴Nathan said, "My lord, King, have you said, 'Adonijah shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne?' ²⁵For he has gone down today, and has slain cattle, fatlings, and sheep in abundance, and has called all the king's sons, the captains of the army, and Abiathar the priest. Behold, they are eating and drinking before him, and saying, 'Long live King Adonijah!' ²⁶But he hasn't called me, even me your servant, Zadok the priest, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and your servant Solomon. ²⁷Was this thing done by my lord the king, and you haven't shown to your servants who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?" ²⁸Then King David answered, "Call Bathsheba in to me." She came into the king's presence and stood before the king. ²⁹The king vowed and said, "As the LORD lives, who has redeemed my soul out of all adversity, ³⁰most certainly as I swore to you by the LORD, the God of Israel, saying, 'Assuredly Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne in my place;' I will most certainly do this today." ³¹Then Bathsheba bowed with her face to the earth and showed respect to the king, and said, "Let my lord King David live forever!" ³²King David said, "Call to me Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada." They came before the

ⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

king. ³³The king said to them, "Take with you the servants of your lord, and cause Solomon my son to ride on my own mule, and bring him down to Gihon. ³⁴Let Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him there king over Israel. Blow the shofar, and say, 'Long live King Solomon!' ³⁵Then come up after him, and he shall come and sit on my throne; for he shall be king in my place. I have appointed him to be prince over Israel and over Judah." ³⁶Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered the king, and said, "Amen. May the LORD, the God of my lord the king, say so. ³⁷As the LORD has been with my lord the king, even so may he be with Solomon, and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord King David." ³⁸So Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites went down and had Solomon ride on King David's mule, and brought him to Gihon. ³⁹Zadok the priest took the horn of oil from the Tent, and anointed Solomon. They blew the shofar; and all the people said, "Long live King Solomon!" ⁴⁰All the people came up after him, and the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth shook with their sound. ⁴¹Adonijah and all the guests who were with him heard it as they had finished eating. When Joab heard the sound of the shofar, he said, "Why is this noise of the city being in an uproar?" ⁴²While he yet spoke, behold, Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest came; and Adonijah said, "Come in; for you are a worthy man, and bring good news." ⁴³Jonathan answered Adonijah, "Most certainly our lord King David has made Solomon king. ⁴⁴The king has sent with him Zadok the priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and they have caused him to ride on the king's mule. ⁴⁵Zadok the priest and Nathan the prophet have anointed him king in Gihon. They have come up from there rejoicing, so that the city rang again. This is the noise that you have heard. ⁴⁶Also, Solomon sits on the throne of the kingdom. ⁴⁷Moreover the king's servants came to bless our lord King David, saying, 'May your God make the name of Solomon better than your name, and make his throne greater than your throne;' and the king bowed himself on the bed. ⁴⁸Also thus said the king, 'Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who has given one to sit on my throne today, my eyes even seeing it.'" ⁴⁹All the guests of Adonijah were afraid, and rose up, and each man went his way. ⁵⁰Adonijah was afraid because of Solomon; and he arose, and went, and hung onto the horns of the altar. ⁵¹Solomon was told, "Behold, Adonijah fears King Solomon; for, behold, he is hanging onto the horns of the altar, saying, 'Let King Solomon swear to me first that he will not kill his servant with the sword.'" ⁵²Solomon said, "If he shows himself a worthy man, not a hair of his shall fall to the earth; but if wickedness is found in him, he shall die." ⁵³So King Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the altar.

He came and bowed down to King Solomon; and Solomon said to him, "Go to your house."

2Now the days of David came near that he should die; and he commanded Solomon his son, saying, ²"I am going the way of all the earth. You be strong therefore, and show yourself a man; ³and keep the instruction of the LORD your God, to walk in his ways, to keep his statutes, his commandments, his ordinances, and his testimonies, according to that which is written in the Torah of Moses, that you may prosper in all that you do and wherever you turn yourself. ⁴Then the LORD may establish his word which he spoke concerning me, saying, 'If your children are careful of their way, to walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, there shall not fail you,' he said, 'a man on the throne of Israel.' ⁵"Moreover you know also what Joab the son of Zeruiah did to me, even what he did to the two captains of the armies of Israel, to Abner the son of Ner and to Amasa the son of Jether, whom he killed, and shed the blood of war in peace, and put the blood of war on his sash that was around his waist and in his sandals that were on his feet. ⁶Do therefore according to your wisdom, and don't let his gray head go down to Sheol ^{iv} in peace. ⁷But show kindness to the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite, and let them be among those who eat at your table; for so they came to me when I fled from Absalom your brother. ⁸"Behold, there is with you Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite of Bahurim, who cursed me with a grievous curse in the day when I went to Mahanaim; but he came down to meet me at the Jordan, and I swore to him by the LORD, saying, 'I will not put you to death with the sword.' ⁹Now therefore don't hold him guiltless, for you are a wise man; and you will know what you ought to do to him, and you shall bring his gray head down to Sheol ^v with blood." ¹⁰David slept with his fathers, and was buried in David's city. ¹¹The days that David reigned over Israel were forty years; he reigned seven years in Hebron, and he reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem. ¹²Solomon sat on David his father's throne; and his kingdom was firmly established. ¹³Then Adonijah the son of Haggith came to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon. She said, "Do you come peaceably?" He said, "Peaceably. ¹⁴He said moreover, I have something to tell you." She said, "Say on." ¹⁵He said, "You know that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should reign. However, the kingdom is turned around, and has become my brother's; for it was his from the LORD. ¹⁶Now I ask one petition of you. Don't deny me." She said to him, "Say on." ¹⁷He said, "Please speak to Solomon the king (for he will not tell you 'no'), that he give me Abishag the Shunammite as wife." ¹⁸Bathsheba said, "All right. I will speak for you to the king." ¹⁹Bathsheba therefore went to King Solomon,

^{iv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^vSheol is the place of the dead.

to speak to him for Adonijah. The king rose up to meet her and bowed himself to her, and sat down on his throne and caused a throne to be set for the king's mother; and she sat on his right hand. ²⁰Then she said, "I ask one small petition of you; don't deny me." The king said to her, "Ask on, my mother, for I will not deny you." ²¹She said, "Let Abishag the Shunammite be given to Adonijah your brother as wife." ²²King Solomon answered his mother, "Why do you ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? Ask for him the kingdom also, for he is my elder brother; even for him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for Joab the son of Zeruiah." ²³Then King Solomon swore by the LORD, saying, "God do so to me, and more also, if Adonijah has not spoken this word against his own life. ²⁴Now therefore as the LORD lives, who has established me and set me on my father David's throne, and who has made me a house as he promised, surely Adonijah shall be put to death today." ²⁵King Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; and he fell on him, so that he died. ²⁶To Abiathar the priest the king said, "Go to Anathoth, to your own fields, for you are worthy of death. But I will not at this time put you to death, because you bore the Lord ^{vi} GOD's ark before David my father, and because you were afflicted in all in which my father was afflicted." ²⁷So Solomon thrust Abiathar out from being priest to the LORD, that he might fulfill the LORD's word which he spoke concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh. ²⁸This news came to Joab; for Joab had followed Adonijah, although he didn't follow Absalom. Joab fled to the LORD's Tent, and held onto the horns of the altar. ²⁹King Solomon was told, "Joab has fled to the LORD's Tent; and behold, he is by the altar." Then Solomon sent Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, saying, "Go, fall on him." ³⁰Benaiah came to the LORD's Tent, and said to him, "The king says, 'Come out!'" He said, "No; but I will die here." Benaiah brought the king word again, saying, "This is what Joab said, and this is how he answered me." ³¹The king said to him, "Do as he has said, and fall on him, and bury him, that you may take away the blood, which Joab shed without cause, from me and from my father's house. ³²The LORD will return his blood on his own head, because he fell on two men more righteous and better than he, and killed them with the sword, and my father David didn't know it: Abner the son of Ner, captain of the army of Israel, and Amasa the son of Jether, captain of the army of Judah. ³³So their blood will return on the head of Joab and on the head of his offspring ^{vii} forever. But for David, for his offspring, for his house, and for his throne, there will be peace forever from the LORD." ³⁴Then Benaiah the son of Jehoiada went up and fell on him, and killed him; and he was buried in his own house in the wilderness. ³⁵The king put Benaiah the son of Jehoiada in his place over

the army; and the king put Zadok the priest in the place of Abiathar. ³⁶The king sent and called for Shimei, and said to him, "Build yourself a house in Jerusalem, and live there, and don't go anywhere else. ³⁷For on the day you go out and pass over the brook Kidron, know for certain that you will surely die. Your blood will be on your own head." ³⁸Shimei said to the king, "What you say is good. As my lord the king has said, so will your servant do." Shimei lived in Jerusalem many days. ³⁹At the end of three years, two of Shimei's slaves ran away to Achish, son of Maacah, king of Gath. They told Shimei, saying, "Behold, your slaves are in Gath." ⁴⁰Shimei arose, saddled his donkey, and went to Gath to Achish to seek his slaves; and Shimei went and brought his slaves from Gath. ⁴¹Solomon was told that Shimei had gone from Jerusalem to Gath, and had come again. ⁴²The king sent and called for Shimei, and said to him, "Didn't I adjure you by the LORD and warn you, saying, 'Know for certain that on the day you go out and walk anywhere else, you shall surely die?' You said to me, 'The saying that I have heard is good.' ⁴³Why then have you not kept the oath of the LORD and the commandment that I have instructed you with?" ⁴⁴The king said moreover to Shimei, "You know in your heart all the wickedness that you did to David my father. Therefore the LORD will return your wickedness on your own head. ⁴⁵But King Solomon will be blessed, and David's throne will be established before the LORD forever." ⁴⁶So the king commanded Benaiah the son of Jehoiada; and he went out, and fell on him, so that he died. The kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon.

3 Solomon made a marriage alliance with Pharaoh king of Egypt. He took Pharaoh's daughter and brought her into David's city until he had finished building his own house, the LORD's house, and the wall around Jerusalem. ²However, the people sacrificed in the high places, because there was not yet a house built for the LORD's name. ³Solomon loved the LORD, walking in the statutes of David his father, except that he sacrificed and burned incense in the high places. ⁴The king went to Gibeon to sacrifice there, for that was the great high place. Solomon offered a thousand burnt offerings on that altar. ⁵In Gibeon, the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, "Ask for what I should give you." ⁶Solomon said, "You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, because he walked before you in truth, in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today. ⁷Now, LORD my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don't know how to go out or come in. ⁸Your servant is among your people which you have chosen, a great people, that can't be numbered or counted for multitude.

^{vi}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{vii}or, seed

⁹Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours?"

¹⁰This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹God said to him, "Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have you asked for riches for yourself, nor have you asked for the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice, ¹²behold, I have done according to your word. Behold, I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been no one like you before you, and after you none will arise like you. ¹³I have also given you that which you have not asked, both riches and honor, so that there will not be any among the kings like you for all your days. ¹⁴If you will walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as your father David walked, then I will lengthen your days."

¹⁵Solomon awoke; and behold, it was a dream. Then he came to Jerusalem and stood before the ark of the LORD's covenant, and offered up burnt offerings, offered peace offerings, and made a feast for all his servants. ¹⁶Then two women who were prostitutes came to the king, and stood before him. ¹⁷The one woman said, "Oh, my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house. I delivered a child with her in the house. ¹⁸The third day after I delivered, this woman delivered also. We were together. There was no stranger with us in the house, just us two in the house. ¹⁹This woman's child died in the night, because she lay on it. ²⁰She arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me while your servant slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom. ²¹When I rose in the morning to nurse my child, behold, he was dead; but when I had looked at him in the morning, behold, it was not my son whom I bore." ²²The other woman said, "No! But the living one is my son, and the dead one is your son." The first one said, "No! But the dead one is your son, and the living one is my son." They argued like this before the king. ²³Then the king said, "One says, 'This is my son who lives, and your son is the dead;' and the other says, 'No! But your son is the dead one, and my son is the living one.'" ²⁴The king said, "Get me a sword." So they brought a sword before the king. ²⁵The king said, "Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other." ²⁶Then the woman whose the living child was spoke to the king, for her heart yearned over her son, and she said, "Oh, my lord, give her the living child, and in no way kill him!" But the other said, "He shall be neither mine nor yours. Divide him." ²⁷Then the king answered, "Give the first woman the living child, and definitely do not kill him. She is his mother." ²⁸All Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king, for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him to do justice.

⁴King Solomon was king over all Israel. ²These were the princes whom he had: Azariah the son of Zadok, the priest; ³Elihoreph and Ahijah, the sons of Shisha, scribes; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, the recorder; ⁴Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the army; Zadok and Abiathar were priests; ⁵Azariah the son of Nathan was over the officers; Zabud the son of Nathan was chief minister, the king's friend; ⁶Ahishar was over the household; and Adoniram the son of Abda was over the men subject to forced labor. ⁷Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, who provided food for the king and his household. Each man had to make provision for a month in the year. ⁸These are their names: Ben Hur, in the hill country of Ephraim; ⁹Ben Deker, in Makaz, in Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh, and Elon Beth Hanan; ¹⁰Ben Hesed, in Arubboth (Socoh and all the land of Hepher belonged to him); ¹¹Ben Abinadab, in all the height of Dor (he had Taphath, Solomon's daughter, as wife); ¹²Baana the son of Ahilud, in Taanach and Megiddo, and all Beth Shean which is beside Zarethan, beneath Jezreel, from Beth Shean to Abel Meholah, as far as beyond Jokmeam; ¹³Ben Geber, in Ramoth Gilead (the towns of Jair the son of Manasseh, which are in Gilead, belonged to him; and the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, sixty great cities with walls and bronze bars, belonged to him); ¹⁴Ahinadab the son of Iddo, in Mahanaim; ¹⁵Ahimaaz, in Naphtali (he also took Basemath the daughter of Solomon as wife); ¹⁶Baana the son of Hushai, in Asher and Bealoth; ¹⁷Jehoshaphat the son of Paruah, in Issachar; ¹⁸Shimei the son of Ela, in Benjamin; ¹⁹Geber the son of Uri, in the land of Gilead, the country of Sihon king of the Amorites and of Og king of Bashan; and he was the only officer who was in the land. ²⁰Judah and Israel were numerous as the sand which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking and making merry. ²¹Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms from the River to the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt. They brought tribute and served Solomon all the days of his life. ²²Solomon's provision for one day was thirty cors ^{viii} of fine flour, sixty measures of meal, ²³ten head of fat cattle, twenty head of cattle out of the pastures, and one hundred sheep, in addition to deer, gazelles, roebucks, and fattened fowl. ²⁴For he had dominion over all on this side the River, from Tiph-sah even to Gaza, over all the kings on this side the River; and he had peace on all sides around him. ²⁵Judah and Israel lived safely, every man under his vine and under his fig tree, from Dan even to Beersheba, all the days of Solomon. ²⁶Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses for his chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen. ²⁷Those officers provided food for King Solomon, and for all who came to King Solomon's table, every man in his month. They let nothing be lacking. ²⁸They also brought barley and straw for the horses and swift steeds to the place where the of-

^{viii}1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels

ficers were, each man according to his duty. ²⁹God gave Solomon abundant wisdom, understanding, and breadth of mind like the sand that is on the seashore. ³⁰Solomon's wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east and all the wisdom of Egypt. ³¹For he was wiser than all men—wiser than Ethan the Ezrahite, Heman, Calcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol; and his fame was in all the nations all around. ³²He spoke three thousand proverbs, and his songs numbered one thousand five. ³³He spoke of trees, from the cedar that is in Lebanon even to the hyssop that grows out of the wall; he also spoke of animals, of birds, of creeping things, and of fish. ³⁴People of all nations came to hear the wisdom of Solomon, sent by all kings of the earth who had heard of his wisdom.

⁵Hiram king of Tyre sent his servants to Solomon, for he had heard that they had anointed him king in the place of his father, and Hiram had always loved David. ²Solomon sent to Hiram, saying, ³“You know that David my father could not build a house for the name of the LORD his God because of the wars which were around him on every side, until the LORD put his enemies under the soles of his feet. ⁴But now the LORD my God has given me rest on every side. There is no enemy and no evil occurrence. ⁵Behold, I intend to build a house for the name of the LORD my God, as the LORD spoke to David my father, saying, ‘Your son, whom I will set on your throne in your place shall build the house for my name.’ ⁶Now therefore command that cedar trees be cut for me out of Lebanon. My servants will be with your servants; and I will give you wages for your servants according to all that you say. For you know that there is nobody among us who knows how to cut timber like the Sidonians.” ⁷When Hiram heard the words of Solomon, he rejoiced greatly, and said, “Blessed is the LORD today, who has given to David a wise son to rule over this great people.” ⁸Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, “I have heard the message which you have sent to me. I will do all your desire concerning timber of cedar, and concerning cypress timber. ⁹My servants will bring them down from Lebanon to the sea. I will make them into rafts to go by sea to the place that you specify to me, and will cause them to be broken up there, and you will receive them. You will accomplish my desire, in giving food for my household.” ¹⁰So Hiram gave Solomon cedar timber and cypress timber according to all his desire. ¹¹Solomon gave Hiram twenty thousand cors ^{ix} of wheat for food to his household, and twenty cors ^x of pure oil. Solomon gave this to Hiram year by year. ¹²The LORD gave Solomon wisdom, as he promised him. There was peace between Hiram and Solomon, and the two of them made a treaty together. ¹³King Solomon raised a levy out

of all Israel; and the levy was thirty thousand men. ¹⁴He sent them to Lebanon, ten thousand a month by courses: for a month they were in Lebanon, and two months at home; and Adoniram was over the men subject to forced labor. ¹⁵Solomon had seventy thousand who bore burdens, and eighty thousand who were stone cutters in the mountains, ¹⁶besides Solomon's chief officers who were over the work: three thousand three hundred who ruled over the people who labored in the work. ¹⁷The king commanded, and they cut out large stones, costly stones, to lay the foundation of the house with worked stone. ¹⁸Solomon's builders and Hiram's builders and the Gebalites cut them, and prepared the timber and the stones to build the house.

⁶In the four hundred and eightieth year after the children of Israel had come out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month Ziv, which is the second month, he began to build the LORD's house. ²The house which King Solomon built for the LORD had a length of sixty cubits, ^{xi} and its width twenty, and its height thirty cubits. ³The porch in front of the temple of the house had a length of twenty cubits, which was along the width of the house. Ten cubits was its width in front of the house. ⁴He made windows of fixed lattice work for the house. ⁵Against the wall of the house, he built floors all around, against the walls of the house all around, both of the temple and of the inner sanctuary; and he made side rooms all around. ⁶The lowest floor was five cubits wide, and the middle was six cubits wide, and the third was seven cubits wide; for on the outside he made offsets in the wall of the house all around, that the beams should not be inserted into the walls of the house. ⁷The house, when it was under construction, was built of stone prepared at the quarry; and no hammer or ax or any tool of iron was heard in the house while it was under construction. ⁸The door for the middle side rooms was in the right side of the house. They went up by winding stairs into the middle floor, and out of the middle into the third. ⁹So he built the house and finished it; and he covered the house with beams and planks of cedar. ¹⁰He built the floors all along the house, each five cubits high; and they rested on the house with timbers of cedar. ¹¹The LORD's word came to Solomon, saying, ¹²“Concerning this house which you are building, if you will walk in my statutes, and execute my ordinances, and keep all my commandments to walk in them, then I will establish my word with you, which I spoke to David your father. ¹³I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will not forsake my people Israel.” ¹⁴So Solomon built the house and finished it. ¹⁵He built the walls of the house within with boards of cedar; from the floor of the house to the walls of the ceiling, he covered them on the inside with wood. He covered the floor of the

^{ix}20,000 cors would be about 120,000 bushels or about 4.2 megaliters of wheat, which would weigh about 3,270 metric tons.

^x20 cors is about 1,100 gallons or about 4220 liters.

^{xi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

house with cypress boards. ¹⁶He built twenty cubits of the back part of the house with boards of cedar from the floor to the ceiling. He built this within, for an inner sanctuary, even for the most holy place. ¹⁷In front of the temple sanctuary was forty cubits long. ¹⁸There was cedar on the house within, carved with buds and open flowers. All was cedar. No stone was visible. ¹⁹He prepared an inner sanctuary in the middle of the house within, to set the ark of the LORD's covenant there. ²⁰Within the inner sanctuary was twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits in width, and twenty cubits in its height. He overlaid it with pure gold. He covered the altar with cedar. ²¹So Solomon overlaid the house within with pure gold. He drew chains of gold across before the inner sanctuary, and he overlaid it with gold. ²²He overlaid the whole house with gold, until all the house was finished. He also overlaid the whole altar that belonged to the inner sanctuary with gold. ²³In the inner sanctuary he made two cherubim ^{xii} of olive wood, each ten cubits high. ²⁴Five cubits was the length of one wing of the cherub, and five cubits was the length of the other wing of the cherub. From the tip of one wing to the tip of the other was ten cubits. ²⁵The other cherub was ten cubits. Both the cherubim were of one measure and one form. ²⁶One cherub was ten cubits high, and so was the other cherub. ²⁷He set the cherubim within the inner house. The wings of the cherubim were stretched out, so that the wing of the one touched the one wall and the wing of the other cherub touched the other wall; and their wings touched one another in the middle of the house. ²⁸He overlaid the cherubim with gold. ²⁹He carved all the walls of the house around with carved figures of cherubim, palm trees, and open flowers, inside and outside. ³⁰He overlaid the floor of the house with gold, inside and outside. ³¹For the entrance of the inner sanctuary, he made doors of olive wood. The lintel and door posts were a fifth part of the wall. ³²So he made two doors of olive wood; and he carved on them carvings of cherubim, palm trees, and open flowers, and overlaid them with gold. He spread the gold on the cherubim and on the palm trees. ³³He also made the entrance of the temple door posts of olive wood, out of a fourth part of the wall, ³⁴and two doors of cypress wood. The two leaves of the one door were folding, and the two leaves of the other door were folding. ³⁵He carved cherubim, palm trees, and open flowers; and he overlaid them with gold fitted on the engraved work. ³⁶He built the inner court with three courses of cut stone and a course of cedar beams. ³⁷The foundation of the LORD's house was laid in the fourth year, in the month Ziv. ³⁸In the eleventh year, in the month Bul, which is the eighth month, the house was finished throughout all its parts and according to all its specifications. So he spent seven years building it.

7 Solomon was building his own house thirteen years,

^{xiii}Cherubim" is plural of "cherub", an angelic being.

and he finished all his house. ²For he built the House of the Forest of Lebanon. Its length was one hundred cubits, ^{xiii} its width fifty cubits, and its height thirty cubits, on four rows of cedar pillars, with cedar beams on the pillars. ³It was covered with cedar above over the forty-five beams that were on the pillars, fifteen in a row. ⁴There were beams in three rows, and window was facing window in three ranks. ⁵All the doors and posts were made square with beams; and window was facing window in three ranks. ⁶He made the hall of pillars. Its length was fifty cubits and its width thirty cubits, with a porch before them, and pillars and a threshold before them. ⁷He made the porch of the throne where he was to judge, even the porch of judgment; and it was covered with cedar from floor to floor. ⁸His house where he was to dwell, the other court within the porch, was of the same construction. He made also a house for Pharaoh's daughter (whom Solomon had taken as wife), like this porch. ⁹All these were of costly stones, even of stone cut according to measure, sawed with saws, inside and outside, even from the foundation to the coping, and so on the outside to the great court. ¹⁰The foundation was of costly stones, even great stones, stones of ten cubits and stones of eight cubits. ¹¹Above were costly stones, even cut stone, according to measure, and cedar wood. ¹²The great court around had three courses of cut stone with a course of cedar beams, like the inner court of the LORD's house and the porch of the house. ¹³King Solomon sent and brought Hiram out of Tyre. ¹⁴He was the son of a widow of the tribe of Naphtali, and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in bronze; and he was filled with wisdom and understanding and skill to work all works in bronze. He came to King Solomon and performed all his work. ¹⁵For he fashioned the two pillars of bronze, eighteen cubits high apiece; and a line of twelve cubits encircled either of them. ¹⁶He made two capitals of molten bronze to set on the tops of the pillars. The height of the one capital was five cubits, and the height of the other capital was five cubits. ¹⁷There were nets of checker work and wreaths of chain work for the capitals which were on the top of the pillars: seven for the one capital, and seven for the other capital. ¹⁸So he made the pillars; and there were two rows of pomegranates around the one network, to cover the capitals that were on the top of the pillars; and he did so for the other capital. ¹⁹The capitals that were on the top of the pillars in the porch were of lily work, four cubits. ²⁰There were capitals above also on the two pillars, close by the belly which was beside the network. There were two hundred pomegranates in rows around the other capital. ²¹He set up the pillars at the porch of the temple. He set up the right pillar and called its name Jachin; and he set up the left pillar and called its name Boaz. ²²On the tops of the pillars was lily work. So the work of the

^{xiii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

pillars was finished. ²³He made the molten sea ten cubits from brim to brim, round in shape. Its height was five cubits; and a line of thirty cubits encircled it. ²⁴Under its brim around there were buds which encircled it for ten cubits, encircling the sea. The buds were in two rows, cast when it was cast. ²⁵It stood on twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, and three looking toward the west, and three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east; and the sea was set on them above, and all their hindquarters were inward. ²⁶It was a hand width thick. Its brim was worked like the brim of a cup, like the flower of a lily. It held two thousand baths. ²⁷He made the ten bases of bronze. The length of one base was four cubits, four cubits its width, and three cubits its height. ²⁸The work of the bases was like this: they had panels; and there were panels between the ledges; ²⁹and on the panels that were between the ledges were lions, oxen, and cherubim; and on the ledges there was a pedestal above; and beneath the lions and oxen were wreaths of hanging work. ³⁰Every base had four bronze wheels and axles of bronze; and its four feet had supports. The supports were cast beneath the basin, with wreaths at the side of each. ³¹Its opening within the capital and above was a cubit. Its opening was round like the work of a pedestal, a cubit and a half; and also on its opening were engravings, and their panels were square, not round. ³²The four wheels were underneath the panels; and the axles of the wheels were in the base. The height of a wheel was a cubit and half a cubit. ³³The work of the wheels was like the work of a chariot wheel. Their axles, their rims, their spokes, and their hubs were all of cast metal. ³⁴There were four supports at the four corners of each base. Its supports were of the base itself. ³⁵In the top of the base there was a round band half a cubit high; and on the top of the base its supports and its panels were the same. ³⁶On the plates of its supports and on its panels, he engraved cherubim, lions, and palm trees, each in its space, with wreaths all around. ³⁷He made the ten bases in this way: all of them had one casting, one measure, and one form. ³⁸He made ten basins of bronze. One basin contained forty baths. ^{xiv}Every basin measured four cubits. One basin was on every one of the ten bases. ³⁹He set the bases, five on the right side of the house and five on the left side of the house. He set the sea on the right side of the house eastward and toward the south. ⁴⁰Hiram made the pots, the shovels, and the basins. So Hiram finished doing all the work that he worked for King Solomon in the LORD's house: ⁴¹the two pillars; the two bowls of the capitals that were on the top of the pillars; the two networks to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the top of the pillars; ⁴²the four hundred pomegranates for the two networks; two rows of pomegranates for each network, to cover the two bowls of

the capitals that were on the pillars; ⁴³the ten bases; the ten basins on the bases; ⁴⁴the one sea; the twelve oxen under the sea; ⁴⁵the pots; the shovels; and the basins. All of these vessels, which Hiram made for King Solomon in the LORD's house, were of burnished bronze. ⁴⁶The king cast them in the plain of the Jordan, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zarethan. ⁴⁷Solomon left all the vessels unweighed, because there were so many of them. The weight of the bronze could not be determined. ⁴⁸Solomon made all the vessels that were in the LORD's house: the golden altar and the table that the show bread was on, of gold; ⁴⁹and the lamp stands, five on the right side and five on the left, in front of the inner sanctuary, of pure gold; and the flowers, the lamps, and the tongs, of gold; ⁵⁰the cups, the snuffers, the basins, the spoons, and the fire pans, of pure gold; and the hinges, both for the doors of the inner house, the most holy place, and for the doors of the house, of the temple, of gold. ⁵¹Thus all the work that King Solomon did in the LORD's house was finished. Solomon brought in the things which David his father had dedicated—the silver, the gold, and the vessels—and put them in the treasuries of the LORD's house.

8Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel with all the heads of the tribes, the princes of the fathers' households of the children of Israel, to King Solomon in Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the LORD's covenant out of David's city, which is Zion. ²All the men of Israel assembled themselves to King Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month. ³All the elders of Israel came, and the priests picked up the ark. ⁴They brought up the LORD's ark, the Tent of Meeting, and all the holy vessels that were in the Tent. The priests and the Levites brought these up. ⁵King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel, who were assembled to him, were with him before the ark, sacrificing sheep and cattle that could not be counted or numbered for multitude. ⁶The priests brought in the ark of the LORD's covenant to its place, into the inner sanctuary of the house, to the most holy place, even under the cherubim's wings. ⁷For the cherubim spread their wings out over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its poles above. ⁸The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the holy place before the inner sanctuary, but they were not seen outside. They are there to this day. ⁹There was nothing in the ark except the two stone tablets which Moses put there at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁰It came to pass, when the priests had come out of the holy place, that the cloud filled the LORD's house, ¹¹so that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud; for the LORD's glory filled the LORD's house. ¹²Then Solomon said, "The LORD has said that he would dwell in the thick darkness. ¹³I have surely built you a

^{xiv}1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters, so 40 baths was about 224 gallons or 840 liters.

house of habitation, a place for you to dwell in forever.”¹⁴The king turned his face around and blessed all the assembly of Israel; and all the assembly of Israel stood.¹⁵He said, “Blessed is the LORD, the God of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to David your father, and has with his hand fulfilled it, saying,¹⁶‘Since the day that I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel to build a house, that my name might be there; but I chose David to be over my people Israel.’¹⁷‘Now it was in the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.¹⁸But the LORD said to David my father, ‘Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart.¹⁹Nevertheless, you shall not build the house; but your son who shall come out of your body, he shall build the house for my name.’²⁰The LORD has established his word that he spoke; for I have risen up in the place of David my father, and I sit on the throne of Israel, as the LORD promised, and have built the house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel.²¹There I have set a place for the ark, in which is the LORD’s covenant, which he made with our fathers when he brought them out of the land of Egypt.”²²Solomon stood before the LORD’s altar in the presence of all the assembly of Israel, and spread out his hands toward heaven;²³and he said, “LORD, the God of Israel, there is no God like you, in heaven above, or on earth beneath; who keeps covenant and loving kindness with your servants who walk before you with all their heart;²⁴who has kept with your servant David my father that which you promised him. Yes, you spoke with your mouth, and have fulfilled it with your hand, as it is today.²⁵Now therefore, may LORD, the God of Israel, keep with your servant David my father that which you have promised him, saying, ‘There shall not fail from you a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel, if only your children take heed to their way, to walk before me as you have walked before me.’²⁶‘Now therefore, God of Israel, please let your word be verified, which you spoke to your servant David my father.²⁷But will God in very deed dwell on the earth? Behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens can’t contain you; how much less this house that I have built!’²⁸Yet have respect for the prayer of your servant and for his supplication, LORD my God, to listen to the cry and to the prayer which your servant prays before you today;²⁹that your eyes may be open toward this house night and day, even toward the place of which you have said, ‘My name shall be there;’ to listen to the prayer which your servant prays toward this place.³⁰Listen to the supplication of your servant, and of your people Israel, when they pray toward this place. Yes, hear in heaven, your dwelling place; and when you hear, forgive.³¹‘If a man sins against his neighbor, and an oath is laid on him to cause him to swear, and he comes and swears before your altar in this house,³²then hear in

heaven, and act, and judge your servants, condemning the wicked, to bring his way on his own head, and justifying the righteous, to give him according to his righteousness.³³‘When your people Israel are struck down before the enemy because they have sinned against you, if they turn again to you and confess your name, and pray and make supplication to you in this house,³⁴then hear in heaven, and forgive the sin of your people Israel, and bring them again to the land which you gave to their fathers.³⁵‘When the sky is shut up and there is no rain because they have sinned against you, if they pray toward this place and confess your name, and turn from their sin when you afflict them,³⁶then hear in heaven, and forgive the sin of your servants, and of your people Israel, when you teach them the good way in which they should walk; and send rain on your land which you have given to your people for an inheritance.³⁷‘If there is famine in the land, if there is pestilence, if there is blight, mildew, locust or caterpillar; if their enemy besieges them in the land of their cities, whatever plague, whatever sickness there is,³⁸whatever prayer and supplication is made by any man, or by all your people Israel, who shall each know the plague of his own heart, and spread out his hands toward this house,³⁹then hear in heaven, your dwelling place, and forgive, and act, and give to every man according to all his ways, whose heart you know (for you, even you only, know the hearts of all the children of men);⁴⁰that they may fear you all the days that they live in the land which you gave to our fathers.⁴¹‘Moreover, concerning the foreigner, who is not of your people Israel, when he comes out of a far country for your name’s sake⁴²(for they shall hear of your great name and of your mighty hand and of your outstretched arm), when he comes and prays toward this house,⁴³hear in heaven, your dwelling place, and do according to all that the foreigner calls to you for; that all the peoples of the earth may know your name, to fear you, as do your people Israel, and that they may know that this house which I have built is called by your name.⁴⁴‘If your people go out to battle against their enemy, by whatever way you shall send them, and they pray to the LORD toward the city which you have chosen, and toward the house which I have built for your name,⁴⁵then hear in heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.⁴⁶‘If they sin against you (for there is no man who doesn’t sin), and you are angry with them and deliver them to the enemy, so that they carry them away captive to the land of the enemy, far off or near;⁴⁷yet if they repent in the land where they are carried captive, and turn again, and make supplication to you in the land of those who carried them captive, saying, ‘We have sinned and have done perversely; we have dealt wickedly,’⁴⁸if they return to you with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their enemies who carried them captive, and pray to you toward their land which you gave to their fathers, the city which you have chosen and

the house which I have built for your name, ⁴⁹then hear their prayer and their supplication in heaven, your dwelling place, and maintain their cause; ⁵⁰and forgive your people who have sinned against you, and all their transgressions in which they have transgressed against you; and give them compassion before those who carried them captive, that they may have compassion on them ⁵¹(for they are your people and your inheritance, which you brought out of Egypt, from the middle of the iron furnace); ⁵²that your eyes may be open to the supplication of your servant and to the supplication of your people Israel, to listen to them whenever they cry to you. ⁵³For you separated them from among all the peoples of the earth to be your inheritance, as you spoke by Moses your servant, when you brought our fathers out of Egypt, Lord GOD.” ⁵⁴It was so, that when Solomon had finished praying all this prayer and supplication to the LORD, he arose from before the LORD’s altar, from kneeling on his knees with his hands spread out toward heaven. ⁵⁵He stood and blessed all the assembly of Israel with a loud voice, saying, ⁵⁶“Blessed be the LORD, who has given rest to his people Israel, according to all that he promised. There has not failed one word of all his good promise, which he promised by Moses his servant. ⁵⁷May the LORD our God be with us as he was with our fathers. Let him not leave us or forsake us, ⁵⁸that he may incline our hearts to him, to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, his statutes, and his ordinances, which he commanded our fathers. ⁵⁹Let these my words, with which I have made supplication before the LORD, be near to the LORD our God day and night, that he may maintain the cause of his servant and the cause of his people Israel, as every day requires; ⁶⁰that all the peoples of the earth may know that the LORD himself is God. There is no one else. ⁶¹“Let your heart therefore be perfect with the LORD our God, to walk in his statutes, and to keep his commandments, as it is today.” ⁶²The king, and all Israel with him, offered sacrifice before the LORD. ⁶³Solomon offered for the sacrifice of peace offerings, which he offered to the LORD, twenty two thousand head of cattle and one hundred twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the children of Israel dedicated the LORD’s house. ⁶⁴The same day the king made the middle of the court holy that was before the LORD’s house; for there he offered the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar that was before the LORD was too little to receive the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat of the peace offerings. ⁶⁵So Solomon held the feast at that time, and all Israel with him, a great assembly, from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of Egypt, before the LORD our God, seven days and seven more days, even fourteen days. ⁶⁶On the eighth day he sent the people away; and they blessed the king, and went to their tents joyful and glad in their hearts for all the goodness that the LORD had shown to David his servant, and to

Israel his people.

⁹When Solomon had finished the building of the LORD’s house, the king’s house, and all Solomon’s desire which he was pleased to do, ²The LORD appeared to Solomon the second time, as he had appeared to him at Gibeon. ³The LORD said to him, “I have heard your prayer and your supplication that you have made before me. I have made this house holy, which you have built, to put my name there forever; and my eyes and my heart shall be there perpetually. ⁴As for you, if you will walk before me as David your father walked, in integrity of heart and in uprightness, to do according to all that I have commanded you, and will keep my statutes and my ordinances, ⁵then I will establish the throne of your kingdom over Israel forever, as I promised to David your father, saying, ‘There shall not fail from you a man on the throne of Israel.’ ⁶But if you turn away from following me, you or your children, and not keep my commandments and my statutes which I have set before you, but go and serve other gods and worship them, ⁷then I will cut off Israel out of the land which I have given them; and I will cast this house, which I have made holy for my name, out of my sight; and Israel will be a proverb and a byword among all peoples. ⁸Though this house is so high, yet everyone who passes by it will be astonished and hiss; and they will say, ‘Why has the LORD done this to this land and to this house?’ ⁹and they will answer, ‘Because they abandoned the LORD their God, who brought their fathers out of the land of Egypt, and embraced other gods, and worshiped them, and served them. Therefore the LORD has brought all this evil on them.’” ¹⁰At the end of twenty years, in which Solomon had built the two houses, the LORD’s house and the king’s house ¹¹(now Hiram the king of Tyre had furnished Solomon with cedar trees and cypress trees, and with gold, according to all his desire), King Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee. ¹²Hiram came out of Tyre to see the cities which Solomon had given him; and they didn’t please him. ¹³He said, “What cities are these which you have given me, my brother?” He called them the land of Cabul ^{xv} to this day. ¹⁴Hiram sent to the king one hundred twenty talents ^{xvi} of gold. ¹⁵This is the reason of the forced labor which King Solomon conscripted: to build the LORD’s house, his own house, Millo, Jerusalem’s wall, Hazor, Megiddo, and Gezer. ¹⁶Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up, taken Gezer, burned it with fire, killed the Canaanites who lived in the city, and given it for a wedding gift to his daughter, Solomon’s wife. ¹⁷Solomon built in the land Gezer, Beth Horon the lower, ¹⁸Baalath, Tamar in the wilderness, ¹⁹all the storage cities that Solomon had, the cities for his chariots, the cities for his horsemen, and that which Solomon desired to

^{xv}“Cabul” sounds like Hebrew for “good-for-nothing”.

^{xvi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 120 talents is about 3.6 metric tons

build for his pleasure in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion. ²⁰As for all the people who were left of the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were not of the children of Israel— ²¹their children who were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel were not able utterly to destroy—of them Solomon raised a levy of bondservants to this day. ²²But of the children of Israel Solomon made no bondservants; but they were the men of war, his servants, his princes, his captains, and rulers of his chariots and of his horsemen. ²³These were the five hundred fifty chief officers who were over Solomon's work, who ruled over the people who labored in the work. ²⁴But Pharaoh's daughter came up out of David's city to her house which Solomon had built for her. Then he built Millo. ²⁵Solomon offered burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar which he built to the LORD three times per year, burning incense with them on the altar that was before the LORD. So he finished the house. ²⁶King Solomon made a fleet of ships in Ezion Geber, which is beside Eloth, on the shore of the Sea of Suf, in the land of Edom. ²⁷Hiram sent in the fleet his servants, sailors who had knowledge of the sea, with the servants of Solomon. ²⁸They came to Ophir, and fetched from there gold, four hundred and twenty talents, ^{xvii} and brought it to King Solomon.

10When the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon concerning the LORD's name, she came to test him with hard questions. ²She came to Jerusalem with a very great caravan, with camels that bore spices, very much gold, and precious stones; and when she had come to Solomon, she talked with him about all that was in her heart. ³Solomon answered all her questions. There wasn't anything hidden from the king which he didn't tell her. ⁴When the queen of Sheba had seen all the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had built, ⁵the food of his table, the sitting of his servants, the attendance of his officials, their clothing, his cup bearers, and his ascent by which he went up to the LORD's house, there was no more spirit in her. ⁶She said to the king, "It was a true report that I heard in my own land of your acts and of your wisdom. ⁷However, I didn't believe the words until I came and my eyes had seen it. Behold, not even half was told me! Your wisdom and prosperity exceed the fame which I heard. ⁸Happy are your men, happy are these your servants who stand continually before you, who hear your wisdom. ⁹Blessed is the LORD your God, who delighted in you, to set you on the throne of Israel. Because the LORD loved Israel forever, therefore he made you king, to do justice and righteousness." ¹⁰She gave the king one hundred twenty talents of gold, and a very great quantity of spices, and precious stones. Never again was there such an abundance of spices as these which

the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon. ¹¹The fleet of Hiram that brought gold from Ophir also brought in from Ophir great quantities of almug trees ^{xviii} and precious stones. ¹²The king made of the almug trees pillars for the LORD's house and for the king's house, harps also and stringed instruments for the singers; no such almug trees came or were seen to this day. ¹³King Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatever she asked, in addition to that which Solomon gave her of his royal bounty. So she turned and went to her own land, she and her servants. ¹⁴Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred sixty-six talents ^{xix} of gold, ¹⁵in addition to that which the traders brought, and the traffic of the merchants, and of all the kings of the mixed people, and of the governors of the country. ¹⁶King Solomon made two hundred bucklers of beaten gold; six hundred shekels ^{xx} of gold went to one buckler. ¹⁷He made three hundred shields of beaten gold; three minas ^{xxi} of gold went to one shield; and the king put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon. ¹⁸Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with the finest gold. ¹⁹There were six steps to the throne, and the top of the throne was round behind; and there were armrests on either side by the place of the seat, and two lions standing beside the armrests. ²⁰Twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other on the six steps. Nothing like it was made in any kingdom. ²¹All King Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were of pure gold. None were of silver, because it was considered of little value in the days of Solomon. ²²For the king had a fleet of ships of Tarshish at sea with Hiram's fleet. Once every three years the fleet of Tarshish came bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks. ²³So King Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth in riches and in wisdom. ²⁴All the earth sought the presence of Solomon to hear his wisdom which God had put in his heart. ²⁵Year after year, every man brought his tribute, vessels of silver, vessels of gold, clothing, armor, spices, horses, and mules. ²⁶Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen. He had one thousand four hundred chariots and twelve thousand horsemen. He kept them in the chariot cities and with the king at Jerusalem. ²⁷The king made silver as common as stones in Jerusalem, and cedars as common as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland. ²⁸The horses which Solomon had were brought out of Egypt. The king's merchants received them in droves, each drove at a price. ²⁹A chariot was imported from Egypt for six hundred shekels

^{xviii}possibly an Indian sandalwood, with nice grain and a pleasant scent, and good for woodworking

^{xix}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 666 talents is about 20 metric tons

^{xx}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels is about 6 kilograms or 13.2 pounds or 192 Troy ounces.

^{xxi}A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds.

^{xvii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 420 talents is about 12.6 metric tons

^{xxii} of silver, and a horse for one hundred fifty shekels; and so they exported them to all the kings of the Hittites and to the kings of Syria.

11 Now King Solomon loved many foreign women, together with the daughter of Pharaoh: women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Sidonians, and Hittites, ² of the nations concerning which the LORD said to the children of Israel, "You shall not go among them, neither shall they come among you, for surely they will turn away your heart after their gods." Solomon joined to these in love. ³ He had seven hundred wives, princesses, and three hundred concubines. His wives turned his heart away. ⁴ When Solomon was old, his wives turned away his heart after other gods; and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as the heart of David his father was. ⁵ For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites. ⁶ Solomon did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and didn't go fully after the LORD, as David his father did. ⁷ Then Solomon built a high place for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, on the mountain that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech the abomination of the children of Ammon. ⁸ So he did for all his foreign wives, who burned incense and sacrificed to their gods. ⁹ The LORD was angry with Solomon, because his heart was turned away from the LORD, the God of Israel, who had appeared to him twice, ¹⁰ and had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not go after other gods; but he didn't keep that which the LORD commanded. ¹¹ Therefore the LORD said to Solomon, "Because this is done by you, and you have not kept my covenant and my statutes, which I have commanded you, I will surely tear the kingdom from you, and will give it to your servant. ¹² Nevertheless, I will not do it in your days, for David your father's sake; but I will tear it out of your son's hand. ¹³ However, I will not tear away all the kingdom; but I will give one tribe to your son, for David my servant's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake which I have chosen." ¹⁴ The LORD raised up an adversary to Solomon: Hadad the Edomite. He was one of the king's offspring in Edom. ¹⁵ For when David was in Edom, and Joab the captain of the army had gone up to bury the slain, and had struck every male in Edom ¹⁶ (for Joab and all Israel remained there six months, until he had cut off every male in Edom), ¹⁷ Hadad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants with him, to go into Egypt, when Hadad was still a little child. ¹⁸ They arose out of Midian and came to Paran; and they took men with them out of Paran, and they came to Egypt, to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave him a house, and appointed him food, and gave him land. ¹⁹ Hadad found great favor in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him as wife the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen. ²⁰ The sister of Tahpenes bore him

Genubath his son, whom Tahpenes weaned in Pharaoh's house; and Genubath was in Pharaoh's house among the sons of Pharaoh. ²¹ When Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab the captain of the army was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, "Let me depart, that I may go to my own country." ²² Then Pharaoh said to him, "But what have you lacked with me, that behold, you seek to go to your own country?" He answered, "Nothing, however only let me depart." ²³ God raised up an adversary to him, Rezon the son of Eliada, who had fled from his lord, Hadadezer king of Zobah. ²⁴ He gathered men to himself, and became captain over a troop, when David killed them of Zobah. They went to Damascus and lived there, and reigned in Damascus. ²⁵ He was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon, in addition to the mischief of Hadad. He abhorred Israel, and reigned over Syria. ²⁶ Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephraimite of Zeredah, a servant of Solomon, whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow, also lifted up his hand against the king. ²⁷ This was the reason why he lifted up his hand against the king: Solomon built Millo, and repaired the breach of his father David's city. ²⁸ The man Jeroboam was a mighty man of valor; and Solomon saw the young man that he was industrious, and he put him in charge of all the labor of the house of Joseph. ²⁹ At that time, when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him on the way. Now Ahijah had clad himself with a new garment; and the two of them were alone in the field. ³⁰ Ahijah took the new garment that was on him, and tore it in twelve pieces. ³¹ He said to Jeroboam, "Take ten pieces; for the LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'Behold, I will tear the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon and will give ten tribes to you' ³² (but he shall have one tribe, for my servant David's sake and for Jerusalem's sake, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel), ³³ because they have forsaken me, and have worshiped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh the god of Moab, and Milcom the god of the children of Ammon. They have not walked in my ways, to do that which is right in my eyes, and to keep my statutes and my ordinances, as David his father did. ³⁴ "However, I will not take the whole kingdom out of his hand, but I will make him prince all the days of his life for David my servant's sake whom I chose, who kept my commandments and my statutes, ³⁵ but I will take the kingdom out of his son's hand and will give it to you, even ten tribes. ³⁶ I will give one tribe to his son, that David my servant may have a lamp always before me in Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen for myself to put my name there. ³⁷ I will take you, and you shall reign according to all that your soul desires, and shall be king over Israel. ³⁸ It shall be, if you will listen to all that I command you, and will walk in my ways, and do that which is right in my eyes, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as David my servant did, that I

^{xxii} A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

will be with you, and will build you a sure house, as I built for David, and will give Israel to you. ³⁹I will afflict the offspring of David for this, but not forever.” ⁴⁰Therefore Solomon sought to kill Jeroboam, but Jeroboam arose and fled into Egypt, to Shishak king of Egypt, and was in Egypt until the death of Solomon. ⁴¹Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, and all that he did, and his wisdom, aren’t they written in the book of the acts of Solomon? ⁴²The time that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel was forty years. ⁴³Solomon slept with his fathers, and was buried in his father David’s city; and Rehoboam his son reigned in his place.

12Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king. ²When Jeroboam the son of Nebat heard of it (for he was yet in Egypt, where he had fled from the presence of King Solomon, and Jeroboam lived in Egypt; ³and they sent and called him), Jeroboam and all the assembly of Israel came, and spoke to Rehoboam, saying, ⁴“Your father made our yoke difficult. Now therefore make the hard service of your father, and his heavy yoke which he put on us, lighter, and we will serve you.” ⁵He said to them, “Depart for three days, then come back to me.” So the people departed. ⁶King Rehoboam took counsel with the old men who had stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, saying, “What counsel do you give me to answer these people?” ⁷They replied, “If you will be a servant to this people today, and will serve them, and answer them with good words, then they will be your servants forever.” ⁸But he abandoned the counsel of the old men which they had given him, and took counsel with the young men who had grown up with him, who stood before him. ⁹He said to them, “What counsel do you give, that we may answer these people who have spoken to me, saying, ‘Make the yoke that your father put on us lighter?’” ¹⁰The young men who had grown up with him said to him, “Tell these people who spoke to you, saying, ‘Your father made our yoke heavy, but make it lighter to us’—tell them, ‘My little finger is thicker than my father’s waist. ¹¹Now my father burdened you with a heavy yoke, but I will add to your yoke. My father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.’” ¹²So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king asked, saying, “Come to me again the third day.” ¹³The king answered the people roughly, and abandoned the counsel of the old men which they had given him, ¹⁴and spoke to them according to the counsel of the young men, saying, “My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add to your yoke. My father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.” ¹⁵So the king didn’t listen to the people; for it was a thing brought about from the LORD, that he might establish his word, which the LORD spoke by Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat. ¹⁶When all Israel saw that

the king didn’t listen to them, the people answered the king, saying, “What portion have we in David? We don’t have an inheritance in the son of Jesse. To your tents, Israel! Now see to your own house, David.” So Israel departed to their tents. ¹⁷But as for the children of Israel who lived in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them. ¹⁸Then King Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was over the men subject to forced labor; and all Israel stoned him to death with stones. King Rehoboam hurried to get himself up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem. ¹⁹So Israel rebelled against David’s house to this day. ²⁰When all Israel heard that Jeroboam had returned, they sent and called him to the congregation, and made him king over all Israel. There was no one who followed David’s house, except for the tribe of Judah only. ²¹When Rehoboam had come to Jerusalem, he assembled all the house of Judah and the tribe of Benjamin, a hundred and eighty thousand chosen men who were warriors, to fight against the house of Israel, to bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam the son of Solomon. ²²But the word of God came to Shemaiah the man of God, saying, ²³“Speak to Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the rest of the people, saying, ²⁴‘The LORD says, “You shall not go up or fight against your brothers, the children of Israel. Everyone return to his house; for this thing is from me.”’” So they listened to the LORD’s word, and returned and went their way, according to the LORD’s word. ²⁵Then Jeroboam built Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim, and lived in it; and he went out from there and built Penuel. ²⁶Jeroboam said in his heart, “Now the kingdom will return to David’s house. ²⁷If this people goes up to offer sacrifices in the LORD’s house at Jerusalem, then the heart of this people will turn again to their lord, even to Rehoboam king of Judah; and they will kill me, and return to Rehoboam king of Judah.” ²⁸So the king took counsel, and made two calves of gold; and he said to them, “It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem. Look and behold your gods, Israel, which brought you up out of the land of Egypt!” ²⁹He set the one in Bethel, and the other he put in Dan. ³⁰This thing became a sin, for the people went even as far as Dan to worship before the one there. ³¹He made houses of high places, and made priests from among all the people, who were not of the sons of Levi. ³²Jeroboam ordained a feast in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month, like the feast that is in Judah, and he went up to the altar. He did so in Bethel, sacrificing to the calves that he had made, and he placed in Bethel the priests of the high places that he had made. ³³He went up to the altar which he had made in Bethel on the fifteenth day in the eighth month, even in the month which he had devised of his own heart; and he ordained a feast for the children of Israel, and went up to the altar to burn incense.

13Behold, a man of God came out of Judah by the LORD's word to Bethel; and Jeroboam was standing by the altar to burn incense. ²He cried against the altar by the LORD's word, and said, "Altar! Altar! the LORD says: 'Behold, a son will be born to David's house, Josiah by name. On you he will sacrifice the priests of the high places who burn incense on you, and they will burn men's bones on you.'" ³He gave a sign the same day, saying, "This is the sign which the LORD has spoken: Behold, the altar will be split apart, and the ashes that are on it will be poured out." ⁴When the king heard the saying of the man of God, which he cried against the altar in Bethel, Jeroboam put out his hand from the altar, saying, "Seize him!" His hand, which he put out against him, dried up, so that he could not draw it back again to himself. ⁵The altar was also split apart, and the ashes poured out from the altar, according to the sign which the man of God had given by the LORD's word. ⁶The king answered the man of God, "Now intercede for the favor of the LORD your God, and pray for me, that my hand may be restored me again." The man of God interceded with the LORD, and the king's hand was restored to him again, and became as it was before. ⁷The king said to the man of God, "Come home with me and refresh yourself, and I will give you a reward." ⁸The man of God said to the king, "Even if you gave me half of your house, I would not go in with you, neither would I eat bread nor drink water in this place; ⁹for so was it commanded me by the LORD's word, saying, 'You shall eat no bread, drink no water, and don't return by the way that you came.'" ¹⁰So he went another way, and didn't return by the way that he came to Bethel. ¹¹Now an old prophet lived in Bethel, and one of his sons came and told him all the works that the man of God had done that day in Bethel. They also told their father the words which he had spoken to the king. ¹²Their father said to them, "Which way did he go?" Now his sons had seen which way the man of God went, who came from Judah. ¹³He said to his sons, "Saddle the donkey for me." So they saddled the donkey for him; and he rode on it. ¹⁴He went after the man of God, and found him sitting under an oak. He said to him, "Are you the man of God who came from Judah?" He said, "I am." ¹⁵Then he said to him, "Come home with me and eat bread." ¹⁶He said, "I may not return with you, nor go in with you. I will not eat bread or drink water with you in this place. ¹⁷For it was said to me by the LORD's word, 'You shall eat no bread or drink water there, and don't turn again to go by the way that you came.'" ¹⁸He said to him, "I also am a prophet as you are; and an angel spoke to me by the LORD's word, saying, 'Bring him back with you into your house, that he may eat bread and drink water.'" He lied to him. ¹⁹So he went back with him, ate bread in his house, and drank water. ²⁰As they sat at the table, the LORD's word came to the prophet who brought him back; ²¹and he

cried out to the man of God who came from Judah, saying, "The LORD says, 'Because you have been disobedient to the LORD's word, and have not kept the commandment which the LORD your God commanded you, ²²but came back, and have eaten bread and drank water in the place of which he said to you, 'Eat no bread, and drink no water,' your body will not come to the tomb of your fathers.'" ²³After he had eaten bread and after he drank, he saddled the donkey for the prophet whom he had brought back. ²⁴When he had gone, a lion met him by the way and killed him. His body was thrown on the path, and the donkey stood by it. The lion also stood by the body. ²⁵Behold, men passed by and saw the body thrown on the path, and the lion standing by the body; and they came and told it in the city where the old prophet lived. ²⁶When the prophet who brought him back from the way heard of it, he said, "It is the man of God who was disobedient to the LORD's word. Therefore the LORD has delivered him to the lion, which has mauled him and slain him, according to the LORD's word which he spoke to him." ²⁷He said to his sons, saying, "Saddle the donkey for me," and they saddled it. ²⁸He went and found his body thrown on the path, and the donkey and the lion standing by the body. The lion had not eaten the body nor mauled the donkey. ²⁹The prophet took up the body of the man of God, and laid it on the donkey, and brought it back. He came to the city of the old prophet to mourn, and to bury him. ³⁰He laid his body in his own grave; and they mourned over him, saying, "Alas, my brother!" ³¹After he had buried him, he spoke to his sons, saying, "When I am dead, bury me in the tomb in which the man of God is buried. Lay my bones beside his bones. ³²For the saying which he cried by the LORD's word against the altar in Bethel, and against all the houses of the high places which are in the cities of Samaria, will surely happen." ³³After this thing, Jeroboam didn't turn from his evil way, but again made priests of the high places from among all the people. Whoever wanted to, he consecrated him, that there might be priests of the high places. ³⁴This thing became sin to the house of Jeroboam, even to cut it off and to destroy it from off the surface of the earth.

14At that time Abijah the son of Jeroboam became sick. ²Jeroboam said to his wife, "Please get up and disguise yourself, so that you won't be recognized as Jeroboam's wife. Go to Shiloh. Behold, Ahijah the prophet is there, who said that I would be king over this people. ³Take with you ten loaves of bread, some cakes, and a jar of honey, and go to him. He will tell you what will become of the child." ⁴Jeroboam's wife did so, and arose and went to Shiloh, and came to Ahijah's house. Now Ahijah could not see, for his eyes were set by reason of his age. ⁵The LORD said to Ahijah, "Behold, Jeroboam's wife is coming to inquire of you concerning her son, for he is sick. Tell

her such and such; for it will be, when she comes in, that she will pretend to be another woman.”⁶ So when Ahijah heard the sound of her feet as she came in at the door, he said, “Come in, Jeroboam’s wife! Why do you pretend to be another? For I am sent to you with heavy news.”⁷ Go, tell Jeroboam, ‘The LORD, the God of Israel, says: “Because I exalted you from among the people, and made you prince over my people Israel,⁸ and tore the kingdom away from David’s house, and gave it you; and yet you have not been as my servant David, who kept my commandments, and who followed me with all his heart, to do that only which was right in my eyes,⁹ but have done evil above all who were before you, and have gone and made for yourself other gods, molten images, to provoke me to anger, and have cast me behind your back,¹⁰ therefore, behold, I will bring evil on the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off from Jeroboam everyone who urinates on a wall,^{xxiii} he who is shut up and he who is left at large in Israel, and will utterly sweep away the house of Jeroboam, as a man sweeps away dung until it is all gone.”¹¹ The dogs will eat he who belongs to Jeroboam who dies in the city; and the birds of the sky will eat he who dies in the field, for the LORD has spoken it.”¹² Arise therefore, and go to your house. When your feet enter into the city, the child will die.¹³ All Israel will mourn for him and bury him; for he only of Jeroboam will come to the grave, because in him there is found some good thing toward the LORD, the God of Israel, in the house of Jeroboam.¹⁴ Moreover the LORD will raise up a king for himself over Israel who will cut off the house of Jeroboam. This is the day! What? Even now.¹⁵ For the LORD will strike Israel, as a reed is shaken in the water; and he will root up Israel out of this good land which he gave to their fathers, and will scatter them beyond the River,^{xxiv} because they have made their Asherah poles, provoking the LORD to anger.¹⁶ He will give Israel up because of the sins of Jeroboam, which he has sinned, and with which he has made Israel to sin.”¹⁷ Jeroboam’s wife arose and departed, and came to Tirzah. As she came to the threshold of the house, the child died.¹⁸ All Israel buried him and mourned for him, according to the LORD’s word, which he spoke by his servant Ahijah the prophet.¹⁹ The rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he fought and how he reigned, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.²⁰ The days which Jeroboam reigned were twenty two years; then he slept with his fathers, and Nadab his son reigned in his place.²¹ Rehoboam the son of Solomon reigned in Judah. Rehoboam was forty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. His mother’s name was Naamah the Ammonitess.²² Judah did that which was evil in the

LORD’s sight, and they provoked him to jealousy with their sins which they committed, above all that their fathers had done.²³ For they also built for themselves high places, sacred pillars, and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every green tree.²⁴ There were also sodomites in the land. They did according to all the abominations of the nations which the LORD drove out before the children of Israel.²⁵ In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem;²⁶ and he took away the treasures of the LORD’s house and the treasures of the king’s house. He even took away all of it, including all the gold shields which Solomon had made.²⁷ King Rehoboam made shields of bronze in their place, and committed them to the hands of the captains of the guard, who kept the door of the king’s house.²⁸ It was so, that as often as the king went into the LORD’s house, the guard bore them, and brought them back into the guard room.²⁹ Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, and all that he did, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?³⁰ There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually.³¹ Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David’s city. His mother’s name was Naamah the Ammonitess. Abijam his son reigned in his place.

15 Now in the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam the son of Nebat, Abijam began to reign over Judah.² He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom.³ He walked in all the sins of his father, which he had done before him; and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as the heart of David his father.⁴ Nevertheless for David’s sake, the LORD his God gave him a lamp in Jerusalem, to set up his son after him and to establish Jerusalem;⁵ because David did that which was right in the LORD’s eyes, and didn’t turn away from anything that he commanded him all the days of his life, except only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.⁶ Now there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of his life.⁷ The rest of the acts of Abijam, and all that he did, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? There was war between Abijam and Jeroboam.⁸ Abijam slept with his fathers, and they buried him in David’s city; and Asa his son reigned in his place.⁹ In the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa began to reign over Judah.¹⁰ He reigned forty-one years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom.¹¹ Asa did that which was right in the LORD’s eyes, as David his father did.¹² He put away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols that his fathers had made.¹³ He also removed Maacah his mother from being queen, because she had made an abominable image for an Asherah. Asa cut down her image and burned it at the brook Kidron.¹⁴ But the high places were not taken away. Nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect with the

^{xxiii} or, male

^{xxiv} That is, the Euphrates.

LORD all his days. ¹⁵He brought into the LORD's house the things that his father had dedicated, and the things that he himself had dedicated: silver, gold, and utensils. ¹⁶There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days. ¹⁷Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not allow anyone to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah. ¹⁸Then Asa took all the silver and the gold that was left in the treasures of the LORD's house, and the treasures of the king's house, and delivered it into the hand of his servants. Then King Asa sent them to Ben Hadad, the son of Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, who lived at Damascus, saying, ¹⁹"Let there be a treaty between me and you, like that between my father and your father. Behold, I have sent to you a present of silver and gold. Go, break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me." ²⁰Ben Hadad listened to King Asa, and sent the captains of his armies against the cities of Israel, and struck Ijon, and Dan, and Abel Beth Maacah, and all Chinneroth, with all the land of Naphtali. ²¹When Baasha heard of it, he stopped building Ramah, and lived in Tirzah. ²²Then King Asa made a proclamation to all Judah. No one was exempted. They carried away the stones of Ramah, and its timber, with which Baasha had built; and King Asa used it to build Geba of Benjamin, and Mizpah. ²³Now the rest of all the acts of Asa, and all his might, and all that he did, and the cities which he built, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? But in the time of his old age he was diseased in his feet. ²⁴Asa slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in his father David's city; and Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his place. ²⁵Nadab the son of Jeroboam began to reign over Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah; and he reigned over Israel two years. ²⁶He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and walked in the way of his father, and in his sin with which he made Israel to sin. ²⁷Baasha the son of Ahijah, of the house of Issachar, conspired against him; and Baasha struck him at Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines; for Nadab and all Israel were besieging Gibbethon. ²⁸Even in the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasha killed him and reigned in his place. ²⁹As soon as he was king, he struck all the house of Jeroboam. He didn't leave to Jeroboam any who breathed, until he had destroyed him, according to the saying of the LORD, which he spoke by his servant Ahijah the Shilonite; ³⁰for the sins of Jeroboam which he sinned, and with which he made Israel to sin, because of his provocation with which he provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger. ³¹Now the rest of the acts of Nadab, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ³²There was war between Asa and Baasha king of Israel all their days. ³³In the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasha the son of Ahijah began to reign over all Israel in Tirzah for twenty-four years. ³⁴He did that

which was evil in the LORD's sight, and walked in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin with which he made Israel to sin.

16The LORD's word came to Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha, saying, ²"Because I exalted you out of the dust and made you prince over my people Israel, and you have walked in the way of Jeroboam and have made my people Israel to sin, to provoke me to anger with their sins, ³behold, I will utterly sweep away Baasha and his house; and I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat. ⁴The dogs will eat Baasha's descendants who die in the city; and he who dies of his in the field, the birds of the sky will eat." ⁵Now the rest of the acts of Baasha, and what he did, and his might, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ⁶Baasha slept with his fathers, and was buried in Tirzah; and Elah his son reigned in his place. ⁷Moreover the LORD's word came by the prophet Jehu the son of Hanani against Baasha and against his house, both because of all the evil that he did in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger with the work of his hands, in being like the house of Jeroboam, and because he struck him. ⁸In the twenty-sixth year of Asa king of Judah, Elah the son of Baasha began to reign over Israel in Tirzah for two years. ⁹His servant Zimri, captain of half his chariots, conspired against him. Now he was in Tirzah, drinking himself drunk in the house of Arza, who was over the household in Tirzah; ¹⁰and Zimri went in and struck him and killed him in the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah, and reigned in his place. ¹¹When he began to reign, as soon as he sat on his throne, he attacked all the house of Baasha. He didn't leave him a single one who urinates on a wall ^{xxv} among his relatives or his friends. ¹²Thus Zimri destroyed all the house of Baasha, according to the LORD's word which he spoke against Baasha by Jehu the prophet, ¹³for all the sins of Baasha, and the sins of Elah his son, which they sinned and with which they made Israel to sin, to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger with their vanities. ¹⁴Now the rest of the acts of Elah, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ¹⁵In the twenty-seventh year of Asa king of Judah, Zimri reigned seven days in Tirzah. Now the people were encamped against Gibbethon, which belonged to the Philistines. ¹⁶The people who were encamped heard that Zimri had conspired, and had also killed the king. Therefore all Israel made Omri, the captain of the army, king over Israel that day in the camp. ¹⁷Omri went up from Gibbethon, and all Israel with him, and they besieged Tirzah. ¹⁸When Zimri saw that the city was taken, he went into the fortified part of the king's house and burned the king's house over him with fire, and died, ¹⁹for his sins which he sinned in doing that which was evil in the LORD's sight, in walking in

^{xxv}or, male

the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin which he did to make Israel to sin. ²⁰Now the rest of the acts of Zimri, and his treason that he committed, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ²¹Then the people of Israel were divided into two parts: half of the people followed Tibni the son of Ginath, to make him king, and half followed Omri. ²²But the people who followed Omri prevailed against the people who followed Tibni the son of Ginath; so Tibni died, and Omri reigned. ²³In the thirty-first year of Asa king of Judah, Omri began to reign over Israel for twelve years. He reigned six years in Tirzah. ²⁴He bought the hill Samaria of Shemer for two talents ^{xxvi} of silver; and he built on the hill, and called the name of the city which he built, Samaria, after the name of Shemer, the owner of the hill. ²⁵Omri did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and dealt wickedly above all who were before him. ²⁶For he walked in all the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and in his sins with which he made Israel to sin, to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger with their vanities. ²⁷Now the rest of the acts of Omri which he did, and his might that he showed, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ²⁸So Omri slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria; and Ahab his son reigned in his place. ²⁹In the thirty-eighth year of Asa king of Judah, Ahab the son of Omri began to reign over Israel. Ahab the son of Omri reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty-two years. ³⁰Ahab the son of Omri did that which was evil in the LORD's sight above all that were before him. ³¹As if it had been a light thing for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, he took as wife Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and went and served Baal and worshiped him. ³²He raised up an altar for Baal in the house of Baal, which he had built in Samaria. ³³Ahab made the Asherah; and Ahab did more yet to provoke the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger than all the kings of Israel who were before him. ³⁴In his days Hiel the Bethelite built Jericho. He laid its foundation with the loss of Abiram his firstborn, and set up its gates with the loss of his youngest son Segub, according to the LORD's word, which he spoke by Joshua the son of Nun.

¹⁷Elijah the Tishbite, who was one of the settlers of Gilead, said to Ahab, "As the LORD, the God of Israel, lives, before whom I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to my word." ²Then the LORD's word came to him, saying, ³"Go away from here, turn eastward, and hide yourself by the brook Cherith, that is before the Jordan. ⁴You shall drink from the brook. I have commanded the ravens to feed you there." ⁵So he went and did according to the LORD's word, for he went and lived by the brook Cherith that is before the Jordan. ⁶The ravens brought him bread and meat in the morning,

and bread and meat in the evening; and he drank from the brook. ⁷After a while, the brook dried up, because there was no rain in the land. ⁸The LORD's word came to him, saying, ⁹"Arise, go to Zarephath, which belongs to Sidon, and stay there. Behold, I have commanded a widow there to sustain you." ¹⁰So he arose and went to Zarephath; and when he came to the gate of the city, behold, a widow was there gathering sticks. He called to her and said, "Please get me a little water in a jar, that I may drink." ¹¹As she was going to get it, he called to her and said, "Please bring me a morsel of bread in your hand." ¹²She said, "As the LORD your God lives, I don't have anything baked, but only a handful of meal in a jar and a little oil in a jar. Behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and bake it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die." ¹³Elijah said to her, "Don't be afraid. Go and do as you have said; but make me a little cake from it first, and bring it out to me, and afterward make some for you and for your son. ¹⁴For the LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'The jar of meal will not run out, and the jar of oil will not fail, until the day that the LORD sends rain on the earth.'" ¹⁵She went and did according to the saying of Elijah; and she, he, and her household ate many days. ¹⁶The jar of meal didn't run out and the jar of oil didn't fail, according to the LORD's word, which he spoke by Elijah. ¹⁷After these things, the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, became sick; and his sickness was so severe that there was no breath left in him. ¹⁸She said to Elijah, "What have I to do with you, you man of God? You have come to me to bring my sin to memory, and to kill my son!" ¹⁹He said to her, "Give me your son." He took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into the room where he stayed, and laid him on his own bed. ²⁰He cried to the LORD and said, "LORD my God, have you also brought evil on the widow with whom I am staying, by killing her son?" ²¹He stretched himself on the child three times, and cried to the LORD and said, "LORD my God, please let this child's soul come into him again." ²²The LORD listened to the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived. ²³Elijah took the child and brought him down out of the room into the house, and delivered him to his mother; and Elijah said, "Behold, your son lives." ²⁴The woman said to Elijah, "Now I know that you are a man of God, and that the LORD's word in your mouth is truth."

¹⁸After many days, the LORD's word came to Elijah, in the third year, saying, "Go, show yourself to Ahab; and I will send rain on the earth." ²Elijah went to show himself to Ahab. The famine was severe in Samaria. ³Ahab called Obadiah, who was over the household. (Now Obadiah feared the LORD greatly; ⁴for when Jezebel cut off the LORD's prophets, Obadiah took one hundred prophets, and hid them fifty to a cave, and fed them with bread and

^{xxvi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

water.) ⁵Ahab said to Obadiah, "Go through the land, to all the springs of water, and to all the brooks. Perhaps we may find grass and save the horses and mules alive, that we not lose all the animals." ⁶So they divided the land between them to pass throughout it. Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went another way by himself. ⁷As Obadiah was on the way, behold, Elijah met him. He recognized him, and fell on his face, and said, "Is it you, my lord Elijah?" ⁸He answered him, "It is I. Go, tell your lord, 'Behold, Elijah is here!'" ⁹He said, "How have I sinned, that you would deliver your servant into the hand of Ahab, to kill me?" ¹⁰As the LORD your God lives, there is no nation or kingdom where my lord has not sent to seek you. When they said, 'He is not here,' he took an oath of the kingdom and nation that they didn't find you. ¹¹Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Behold, Elijah is here."' ¹²It will happen, as soon as I leave you, that the LORD's Spirit will carry you I don't know where; and so when I come and tell Ahab, and he can't find you, he will kill me. But I, your servant, have feared the LORD from my youth. ¹³Wasn't it told my lord what I did when Jezebel killed the LORD's prophets, how I hid one hundred men of the LORD's prophets with fifty to a cave, and fed them with bread and water? ¹⁴Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Behold, Elijah is here."' He will kill me." ¹⁵Elijah said, "As the LORD of Hosts lives, before whom I stand, I will surely show myself to him today." ¹⁶So Obadiah went to meet Ahab, and told him; and Ahab went to meet Elijah. ¹⁷When Ahab saw Elijah, Ahab said to him, "Is that you, you troubler of Israel?" ¹⁸He answered, "I have not troubled Israel, but you and your father's house, in that you have forsaken the LORD's commandments and you have followed the Baals. ¹⁹Now therefore send, and gather to me all Israel to Mount Carmel, and four hundred fifty of the prophets of Baal, and four hundred of the prophets of the Asherah, who eat at Jezebel's table." ²⁰So Ahab sent to all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together to Mount Carmel. ²¹Elijah came near to all the people, and said, "How long will you waver between the two sides? If the LORD is God, follow him; but if Baal, then follow him." The people didn't say a word. ²²Then Elijah said to the people, "I, even I only, am left as a prophet of the LORD; but Baal's prophets are four hundred fifty men. ²³Let them therefore give us two bulls; and let them choose one bull for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it on the wood, and put no fire under; and I will dress the other bull, and lay it on the wood, and put no fire under it. ²⁴You call on the name of your god, and I will call on the LORD's name. The God who answers by fire, let him be God." All the people answered, "What you say is good." ²⁵Elijah said to the prophets of Baal, "Choose one bull for yourselves, and dress it first, for you are many; and call on the name of your god, but put no fire under it." ²⁶They took the bull which was given them, and they

dressed it, and called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying, "Baal, hear us!" But there was no voice, and nobody answered. They leaped about the altar which was made. ²⁷At noon, Elijah mocked them, and said, "Cry aloud, for he is a god. Either he is deep in thought, or he has gone somewhere, or he is on a journey, or perhaps he sleeps and must be awakened." ²⁸They cried aloud, and cut themselves in their way with knives and lances until the blood gushed out on them. ²⁹When midday was past, they prophesied until the time of the evening offering; but there was no voice, no answer, and nobody paid attention. ³⁰Elijah said to all the people, "Come near to me!"; and all the people came near to him. He repaired the LORD's altar that had been thrown down. ³¹Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, to whom the LORD's word came, saying, "Israel shall be your name." ³²With the stones he built an altar in the LORD's name. He made a trench around the altar large enough to contain two seahs ^{xxxvii} of seed. ³³He put the wood in order, and cut the bull in pieces and laid it on the wood. He said, "Fill four jars with water, and pour it on the burnt offering and on the wood." ³⁴He said, "Do it a second time;" and they did it the second time. He said, "Do it a third time;" and they did it the third time. ³⁵The water ran around the altar; and he also filled the trench with water. ³⁶At the time of the evening offering, Elijah the prophet came near and said, "LORD, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Israel, let it be known today that you are God in Israel and that I am your servant, and that I have done all these things at your word. ³⁷Hear me, LORD, hear me, that this people may know that you, LORD, are God, and that you have turned their heart back again." ³⁸Then the LORD's fire fell and consumed the burnt offering, the wood, the stones, and the dust; and it licked up the water that was in the trench. ³⁹When all the people saw it, they fell on their faces. They said, "The LORD, he is God! the LORD, he is God!" ⁴⁰Elijah said to them, "Seize the prophets of Baal! Don't let one of them escape!" They seized them; and Elijah brought them down to the brook Kishon, and killed them there. ⁴¹Elijah said to Ahab, "Get up, eat and drink; for there is the sound of abundance of rain." ⁴²So Ahab went up to eat and to drink. Elijah went up to the top of Carmel; and he bowed himself down on the earth, and put his face between his knees. ⁴³He said to his servant, "Go up now and look toward the sea." He went up and looked, then said, "There is nothing." He said, "Go again" seven times. ⁴⁴On the seventh time, he said, "Behold, a small cloud, like a man's hand, is rising out of the sea." He said, "Go up, tell Ahab, 'Get ready and go down, so that the rain doesn't stop you.'" ⁴⁵In a little while, the sky grew black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. Ahab rode, and went to Jezreel. ⁴⁶The LORD's hand was on Elijah; and he tucked his cloak into

^{xxxvii}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

his belt and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.

19Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and how he had killed all the prophets with the sword. ²Then Jezebel sent a messenger to Elijah, saying, "So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I don't make your life as the life of one of them by tomorrow about this time!" ³When he saw that, he arose and ran for his life, and came to Beer-sheba, which belongs to Judah, and left his servant there. ⁴But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a juniper tree. Then he requested for himself that he might die, and said, "It is enough. Now, O LORD, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers." ⁵He lay down and slept under a juniper tree; and behold, an angel touched him, and said to him, "Arise and eat!" ⁶He looked, and behold, there was at his head a cake baked on the coals, and a jar of water. He ate and drank, and lay down again. ⁷The LORD's angel came again the second time, and touched him, and said, "Arise and eat, because the journey is too great for you." ⁸He arose, and ate and drank, and went in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights to Horeb, God's Mountain. ⁹He came to a cave there, and camped there; and behold, the LORD's word came to him, and he said to him, "What are you doing here, Elijah?" ¹⁰He said, "I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of Hosts; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away." ¹¹He said, "Go out and stand on the mountain before the LORD." Behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind tore the mountains and broke in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake; but the LORD was not in the earthquake. ¹²After the earthquake a fire passed; but the LORD was not in the fire. After the fire, there was a still small voice. ¹³When Elijah heard it, he wrapped his face in his mantle, went out, and stood in the entrance of the cave. Behold, a voice came to him, and said, "What are you doing here, Elijah?" ¹⁴He said, "I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of Hosts; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away." ¹⁵The LORD said to him, "Go, return on your way to the wilderness of Damascus. When you arrive, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria. ¹⁶Anoint Jehu the son of Nimshi to be king over Israel; and anoint Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abel Meholah to be prophet in your place. ¹⁷He who escapes from the sword of Hazael, Jehu will kill; and he who escapes from the sword of Jehu, Elisha will kill. ¹⁸Yet I reserved seven thousand in Israel, all the knees of which have not bowed to Baal, and every mouth which has not kissed him." ¹⁹So he departed from there and found

Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen before him, and he with the twelfth. Elijah went over to him and put his mantle on him. ²⁰Elisha left the oxen and ran after Elijah, and said, "Let me please kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow you." He said to him, "Go back again; for what have I done to you?" ²¹He returned from following him, and took the yoke of oxen, killed them, and boiled their meat with the oxen's equipment, and gave to the people; and they ate. Then he arose, and went after Elijah, and served him.

20Ben Hadad the king of Syria gathered all his army together; and there were thirty-two kings with him, with horses and chariots. He went up and besieged Samaria, and fought against it. ²He sent messengers into the city to Ahab king of Israel and said to him, "Ben Hadad says, ³'Your silver and your gold are mine. Your wives also and your children, even the best, are mine.'" ⁴The king of Israel answered, "It is according to your saying, my lord, O king. I am yours, and all that I have." ⁵The messengers came again and said, "Ben Hadad says, 'I sent indeed to you, saying, "You shall deliver me your silver, your gold, your wives, and your children; ⁶but I will send my servants to you tomorrow about this time, and they will search your house and the houses of your servants. Whatever is pleasant in your eyes, they will put it in their hand, and take it away.'"'" ⁷Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land, and said, "Please notice how this man seeks mischief; for he sent to me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver, and for my gold; and I didn't deny him." ⁸All the elders and all the people said to him, "Don't listen, and don't consent." ⁹Therefore he said to the messengers of Ben Hadad, "Tell my lord the king, 'All that you sent for to your servant at the first I will do, but this thing I cannot do.'" The messengers departed and brought him back the message. ¹⁰Ben Hadad sent to him, and said, "The gods do so to me, and more also, if the dust of Samaria will be enough for handfuls for all the people who follow me." ¹¹The king of Israel answered, "Tell him, 'Don't let him who puts on his armor brag like he who takes it off.'" ¹²When Ben Hadad heard this message as he was drinking, he and the kings in the pavilions, he said to his servants, "Prepare to attack!" So they prepared to attack the city. ¹³Behold, a prophet came near to Ahab king of Israel, and said, "The LORD says, 'Have you seen all this great multitude? Behold, I will deliver it into your hand today. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'" ¹⁴Ahab said, "By whom?" He said, "The LORD says, 'By the young men of the princes of the provinces.'" Then he said, "Who shall begin the battle?" He answered, "You." ¹⁵Then he mustered the young men of the princes of the provinces, and they were two hundred and thirty-two. After them, he mustered all the people, even all the children of Israel, being seven thousand. ¹⁶They went out at noon.

But Ben Hadad was drinking himself drunk in the pavilions, he and the kings, the thirty-two kings who helped him. ¹⁷The young men of the princes of the provinces went out first; and Ben Hadad sent out, and they told him, saying, "Men are coming out from Samaria." ¹⁸He said, "If they have come out for peace, take them alive; or if they have come out for war, take them alive." ¹⁹So these went out of the city, the young men of the princes of the provinces, and the army which followed them. ²⁰They each killed his man. The Syrians fled, and Israel pursued them. Ben Hadad the king of Syria escaped on a horse with horsemen. ²¹The king of Israel went out and struck the horses and chariots, and killed the Syrians with a great slaughter. ²²The prophet came near to the king of Israel and said to him, "Go, strengthen yourself, and plan what you must do, for at the return of the year, the king of Syria will come up against you." ²³The servants of the king of Syria said to him, "Their god is a god of the hills; therefore they were stronger than we. But let's fight against them in the plain, and surely we will be stronger than they." ²⁴Do this thing: take the kings away, every man out of his place, and put captains in their place. ²⁵Muster an army like the army that you have lost, horse for horse and chariot for chariot. We will fight against them in the plain, and surely we will be stronger than they are." He listened to their voice and did so. ²⁶At the return of the year, Ben Hadad mustered the Syrians and went up to Aphek to fight against Israel. ²⁷The children of Israel were mustered and given provisions, and went against them. The children of Israel encamped before them like two little flocks of young goats, but the Syrians filled the country. ²⁸A man of God came near and spoke to the king of Israel, and said, "The LORD says, 'Because the Syrians have said, "The LORD is a god of the hills, but he is not a god of the valleys," therefore I will deliver all this great multitude into your hand, and you shall know that I am the LORD.'" ²⁹They encamped opposite each other for seven days. Then on the seventh day the battle was joined; and the children of Israel killed one hundred thousand footmen of the Syrians in one day. ³⁰But the rest fled to Aphek, into the city; and the wall fell on twenty-seven thousand men who were left. Ben Hadad fled and came into the city, into an inner room. ³¹His servants said to him, "See now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings. Please let us put sackcloth on our bodies and ropes on our heads, and go out to the king of Israel. Maybe he will save your life." ³²So they put sackcloth on their bodies and ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said, "Your servant Ben Hadad says, 'Please let me live.'" He said, "Is he still alive? He is my brother." ³³Now the men observed diligently and hurried to take this phrase; and they said, "Your brother Ben Hadad." Then he said, "Go, bring him." Then Ben Hadad came out to him; and he caused him to come up into the chariot. ³⁴Ben Hadad said to him, "The

cities which my father took from your father I will restore. You shall make streets for yourself in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria." "I", said Ahab, "will let you go with this covenant." So he made a covenant with him and let him go. ³⁵A certain man of the sons of the prophets said to his fellow by the LORD's word, "Please strike me!" The man refused to strike him. ³⁶Then he said to him, "Because you have not obeyed the LORD's voice, behold, as soon as you have departed from me, a lion will kill you." As soon as he had departed from him, a lion found him and killed him. ³⁷Then he found another man, and said, "Please strike me." The man struck him and wounded him. ³⁸So the prophet departed and waited for the king by the way, and disguised himself with his headband over his eyes. ³⁹As the king passed by, he cried to the king, and he said, "Your servant went out into the middle of the battle; and behold, a man came over and brought a man to me, and said, 'Guard this man! If by any means he is missing, then your life shall be for his life, or else you shall pay a talent ^{xxviii} of silver.' ⁴⁰As your servant was busy here and there, he was gone." The king of Israel said to him, "So shall your judgment be. You yourself have decided it." ⁴¹He hurried, and took the headband away from his eyes; and the king of Israel recognized that he was one of the prophets. ⁴²He said to him, "The LORD says, 'Because you have let go out of your hand the man whom I had devoted to destruction, therefore your life will take the place of his life, and your people take the place of his people.'" ⁴³The king of Israel went to his house sullen and angry, and came to Samaria.

21After these things, Naboth the Jezreelite had a vineyard which was in Jezreel, next to the palace of Ahab king of Samaria. ²Ahab spoke to Naboth, saying, "Give me your vineyard, that I may have it for a garden of herbs, because it is near my house; and I will give you for it a better vineyard than it. Or, if it seems good to you, I will give you its worth in money." ³Naboth said to Ahab, "May the LORD forbid me, that I should give the inheritance of my fathers to you!" ⁴Ahab came into his house sullen and angry because of the word which Naboth the Jezreelite had spoken to him, for he had said, "I will not give you the inheritance of my fathers." He laid himself down on his bed, and turned away his face, and would eat no bread. ⁵But Jezebel his wife came to him, and said to him, "Why is your spirit so sad that you eat no bread?" ⁶He said to her, "Because I spoke to Naboth the Jezreelite, and said to him, 'Give me your vineyard for money; or else, if it pleases you, I will give you another vineyard for it.' He answered, 'I will not give you my vineyard.'" ⁷Jezebel his wife said to him, "Do you now govern the kingdom of Israel? Arise, and eat bread, and let your heart be merry. I will give you the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite." ⁸So she wrote letters in Ahab's name and sealed them with his

^{xxviii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

seal, and sent the letters to the elders and to the nobles who were in his city, who lived with Naboth. ⁹She wrote in the letters, saying, "Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people." ¹⁰Set two men, wicked fellows, before him, and let them testify against him, saying, 'You cursed God and the king!' Then carry him out, and stone him to death." ¹¹The men of his city, even the elders and the nobles who lived in his city, did as Jezebel had instructed them in the letters which she had written and sent to them. ¹²They proclaimed a fast, and set Naboth on high among the people. ¹³The two men, the wicked fellows, came in and sat before him. The wicked fellows testified against him, even against Naboth, in the presence of the people, saying, "Naboth cursed God and the king!" Then they carried him out of the city and stoned him to death with stones. ¹⁴Then they sent to Jezebel, saying, "Naboth has been stoned and is dead." ¹⁵When Jezebel heard that Naboth had been stoned and was dead, Jezebel said to Ahab, "Arise, take possession of the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which he refused to give you for money; for Naboth is not alive, but dead." ¹⁶When Ahab heard that Naboth was dead, Ahab rose up to go down to the vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take possession of it. ¹⁷The LORD's word came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying, ¹⁸"Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of Israel, who dwells in Samaria. Behold, he is in the vineyard of Naboth, where he has gone down to take possession of it. ¹⁹You shall speak to him, saying, 'The LORD says, "Have you killed and also taken possession?"' You shall speak to him, saying, 'The LORD says, "In the place where dogs licked the blood of Naboth, dogs will lick your blood, even yours."'" ²⁰Ahab said to Elijah, "Have you found me, my enemy?" He answered, "I have found you, because you have sold yourself to do that which is evil in the LORD's sight. ²¹Behold, I will bring evil on you, and will utterly sweep you away and will cut off from Ahab everyone who urinates against a wall, ^{xxix} and him who is shut up and him who is left at large in Israel. ²²I will make your house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah, for the provocation with which you have provoked me to anger, and have made Israel to sin." ²³The LORD also spoke of Jezebel, saying, "The dogs will eat Jezebel by the rampart of Jezreel. ²⁴The dogs will eat he who dies of Ahab in the city; and the birds of the sky will eat he who dies in the field." ²⁵But there was no one like Ahab, who sold himself to do that which was evil in the LORD's sight, whom Jezebel his wife stirred up. ²⁶He did very abominably in following idols, according to all that the Amorites did, whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel. ²⁷When Ahab heard those words, he tore his clothes, put sackcloth on his body, fasted, lay in sackcloth, and went about despondently. ²⁸The LORD's word came to Elijah the Tishbite, saying, ²⁹"See how Ahab

humbles himself before me? Because he humbles himself before me, I will not bring the evil in his days; but I will bring the evil on his house in his son's day."

22 They continued three years without war between Syria and Israel. ²In the third year, Jehoshaphat the king of Judah came down to the king of Israel. ³The king of Israel said to his servants, "You know that Ramoth Gilead is ours, and we do nothing, and don't take it out of the hand of the king of Syria?" ⁴He said to Jehoshaphat, "Will you go with me to battle to Ramoth Gilead?" Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "I am as you are, my people as your people, my horses as your horses." ⁵Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "Please inquire first for the LORD's word." ⁶Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, about four hundred men, and said to them, "Should I go against Ramoth Gilead to battle, or should I refrain?" They said, "Go up; for the Lord will deliver it into the hand of the king." ⁷But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there here a prophet of the LORD, that we may inquire of him?" ⁸The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of the LORD, Micaiah the son of Imlah; but I hate him, for he does not prophesy good concerning me, but evil." Jehoshaphat said, "Don't let the king say so." ⁹Then the king of Israel called an officer, and said, "Quickly get Micaiah the son of Imlah." ¹⁰Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were sitting each on his throne, arrayed in their robes, in an open place at the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets were prophesying before them. ¹¹Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made himself horns of iron, and said, "The LORD says, 'With these you will push the Syrians, until they are consumed.'" ¹²All the prophets prophesied so, saying, "Go up to Ramoth Gilead and prosper; for the LORD will deliver it into the hand of the king." ¹³The messenger who went to call Micaiah spoke to him, saying, "See now, the prophets declare good to the king with one mouth. Please let your word be like the word of one of them, and speak good." ¹⁴Micaiah said, "As the LORD lives, what the LORD says to me, that I will speak." ¹⁵When he had come to the king, the king said to him, "Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall we forbear?" He answered him, "Go up and prosper; and the LORD will deliver it into the hand of the king." ¹⁶The king said to him, "How many times do I have to adjure you that you speak to me nothing but the truth in the LORD's name?" ¹⁷He said, "I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. The LORD said, 'These have no master. Let them each return to his house in peace.'" ¹⁸The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Didn't I tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?" ¹⁹Micaiah said, "Therefore hear the LORD's word. I saw the LORD sitting on his throne, and all the

^{xxix}or, male

army of heaven standing by him on his right hand and on his left. ²⁰The LORD said, ‘Who will entice Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth Gilead?’ One said one thing, and another said another. ²¹A spirit came out and stood before the LORD, and said, ‘I will entice him.’ ²²The LORD said to him, ‘How?’ He said, ‘I will go out and will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.’ He said, ‘You will entice him, and will also prevail. Go out and do so.’ ²³Now therefore, behold, the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these your prophets; and the LORD has spoken evil concerning you.” ²⁴Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near and struck Micaiah on the cheek, and said, “Which way did the LORD’s Spirit go from me to speak to you?” ²⁵Micaiah said, “Behold, you will see on that day when you go into an inner room to hide yourself.” ²⁶The king of Israel said, “Take Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city and to Joash the king’s son. ²⁷Say, ‘The king says, “Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I come in peace.”’” ²⁸Micaiah said, “If you return at all in peace, the LORD has not spoken by me.” He said, “Listen, all you people!” ²⁹So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth Gilead. ³⁰The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, “I will disguise myself and go into the battle, but you put on your robes.” The king of Israel disguised himself and went into the battle. ³¹Now the king of Syria had commanded the thirty-two captains of his chariots, saying, “Don’t fight with small nor great, except only with the king of Israel.” ³²When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, “Surely that is the king of Israel!” and they came over to fight against him. Jehoshaphat cried out. ³³When the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him. ³⁴A certain man drew his bow at random, and struck the king of Israel between the joints of the armor. Therefore he said to the driver of his chariot, “Turn around, and carry me out of the battle, for I am severely wounded.” ³⁵The battle increased that day. The king was propped up in his chariot facing the Syrians, and died at evening. The blood ran out of the wound into the bottom of the chariot. ³⁶A cry went throughout the army about the going down of the sun, saying, “Every man to his city, and every man to his country!” ³⁷So the king died, and was brought to Samaria; and they buried the king in Samaria. ³⁸They washed the chariot by the pool of Samaria; and the dogs licked up his blood where the prostitutes washed themselves, according to the LORD’s word which he spoke. ³⁹Now the rest of the acts of Ahab, and all that he did, and the ivory house which he built, and all the cities that he built, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ⁴⁰So Ahab slept with his fathers; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place. ⁴¹Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah

in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel. ⁴²Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi. ⁴³He walked in all the way of Asa his father. He didn’t turn away from it, doing that which was right in the LORD’s eyes. However, the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places. ⁴⁴Jehoshaphat made peace with the king of Israel. ⁴⁵Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, and his might that he showed, and how he fought, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ⁴⁶The remnant of the sodomites, that remained in the days of his father Asa, he put away out of the land. ⁴⁷There was no king in Edom. A deputy ruled. ⁴⁸Jehoshaphat made ships of Tarshish to go to Ophir for gold, but they didn’t go, for the ships wrecked at Ezion Geber. ⁴⁹Then Ahaziah the son of Ahab said to Jehoshaphat, “Let my servants go with your servants in the ships.” But Jehoshaphat would not. ⁵⁰Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in his father David’s city. Jehoram his son reigned in his place. ⁵¹Ahaziah the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and he reigned two years over Israel. ⁵²He did that which was evil in the LORD’s sight, and walked in the way of his father, and in the way of his mother, and in the way of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, in which he made Israel to sin. ⁵³He served Baal and worshiped him, and provoked the LORD, the God of Israel, to anger in all the ways that his father had done so.

2 Kings

¹Moab rebelled against Israel after the death of Ahab. ²Ahaziah fell down through the lattice in his upper room that was in Samaria, and was sick. So he sent messengers, and said to them, “Go, inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron, whether I will recover of this sickness.” ³But the LORD’s ⁱangel said to Elijah the Tishbite, “Arise, go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria, and tell them, ‘Is it because there is no God ⁱⁱ in Israel that you go to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron?’” ⁴Now therefore the LORD says, “You will not come down from the bed where you have gone up, but you will surely die.”” Then Elijah departed. ⁵The messengers returned to him, and he said to them, “Why is it that you have returned?” ⁶They said to him, “A man came up to meet us, and said to us, ‘Go, return to the king who sent you, and tell him, “The LORD says, ‘Is it because there is no God in Israel that you send to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore you will not come down from the bed where you have gone up, but you will surely die.’”’” ⁷He said to them, “What kind of man was he who came up to meet you and told you these words?” ⁸They answered him, “He was a hairy man, and wearing a leather belt around his waist.” He said, “It’s Elijah the Tishbite.” ⁹Then the king sent a captain of fifty with his fifty to him. He went up to him; and behold, ⁱⁱⁱ he was sitting on the top of the hill. He said to him, “Man of God, the king has said, ‘Come down!’” ¹⁰Elijah answered to the captain of fifty, “If I am a man of God, then let fire come down from the sky and consume you and your fifty!” Then fire came down from the sky, and consumed him and his fifty. ¹¹Again he sent to him another captain of fifty with his fifty. He answered him, “Man of God, the king has said, ‘Come down quickly!’” ¹²Elijah answered them, “If I am a man of God, then let fire come down from the sky and consume you and your fifty!” Then God’s fire came down from the sky, and consumed him and his fifty. ¹³Again he sent the captain of a third fifty with his fifty. The third captain of fifty went up, and came and fell on his knees before Elijah, and begged him, and said to him,

“Man of God, please let my life and the life of these fifty of your servants be precious in your sight. ¹⁴Behold, fire came down from the sky and consumed the last two captains of fifty with their fifties. But now let my life be precious in your sight.” ¹⁵The LORD’s angel said to Elijah, “Go down with him. Don’t be afraid of him.” Then he arose and went down with him to the king. ¹⁶He said to him, “The LORD says, ‘Because you have sent messengers to inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron, is it because there is no God in Israel to inquire of his word? Therefore you will not come down from the bed where you have gone up, but you will surely die.’” ¹⁷So he died according to the LORD’s word which Elijah had spoken. Jehoram began to reign in his place in the second year of Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, because he had no son. ¹⁸Now the rest of the acts of Ahaziah which he did, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

²When the LORD was about to take Elijah up by a whirlwind into heaven, Elijah went with Elisha from Gilgal. ²Elijah said to Elisha, “Please wait here, for the LORD has sent me as far as Bethel.” Elisha said, “As the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, I will not leave you.” So they went down to Bethel. ³The sons of the prophets who were at Bethel came out to Elisha, and said to him, “Do you know that the LORD will take away your master from over you today?” He said, “Yes, I know it. Hold your peace.” ⁴Elijah said to him, “Elisha, please wait here, for the LORD has sent me to Jericho.” He said, “As the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, I will not leave you.” So they came to Jericho. ⁵The sons of the prophets who were at Jericho came near to Elisha, and said to him, “Do you know that the LORD will take away your master from over you today?” He answered, “Yes, I know it. Hold your peace.” ⁶Elijah said to him, “Please wait here, for the LORD has sent me to the Jordan.” He said, “As the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, I will not leave you.” Then they both went on. ⁷Fifty men of the sons of the prophets went and stood opposite them at a distance; and they both stood by the Jordan. ⁸Elijah took his mantle, and rolled it up, and struck the waters; and they were divided here and there, so that they both went over on dry ground. ⁹When they had gone over, Elijah said to

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is “Elohim.”

ⁱⁱⁱ“Behold”, from “ ” means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Elisha, "Ask what I shall do for you, before I am taken from you." Elisha said, "Please let a double portion of your spirit be on me." ¹⁰He said, "You have asked a hard thing. If you see me when I am taken from you, it will be so for you; but if not, it will not be so." ¹¹As they continued on and talked, behold, a chariot of fire and horses of fire separated them; and Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven. ¹²Elisha saw it, and he cried, "My father, my father, the chariots of Israel and its horsemen!" He saw him no more. Then he took hold of his own clothes and tore them in two pieces. ¹³He also took up Elijah's mantle that fell from him, and went back and stood by the bank of the Jordan. ¹⁴He took Elijah's mantle that fell from him, and struck the waters, and said, "Where is the LORD, the God of Elijah?" When he also had struck the waters, they were divided apart, and Elisha went over. ¹⁵When the sons of the prophets who were at Jericho facing him saw him, they said, "The spirit of Elijah rests on Elisha." They came to meet him, and bowed themselves to the ground before him. ¹⁶They said to him, "See now, there are with your servants fifty strong men. Please let them go and seek your master. Perhaps the LORD's Spirit has taken him up, and put him on some mountain or into some valley." He said, "Don't send them." ¹⁷When they urged him until he was ashamed, he said, "Send them." Therefore they sent fifty men; and they searched for three days, but didn't find him. ¹⁸They came back to him while he stayed at Jericho; and he said to them, "Didn't I tell you, 'Don't go?'" ¹⁹The men of the city said to Elisha, "Behold, please, the situation of this city is pleasant, as my lord sees; but the water is bad, and the land is barren." ²⁰He said, "Bring me a new jar, and put salt in it." Then they brought it to him. ²¹He went out to the spring of the waters, and threw salt into it, and said, "The LORD says, 'I have healed these waters. There shall not be from there any more death or barren wasteland.'" ²²So the waters were healed to this day, according to Elisha's word which he spoke. ²³He went up from there to Bethel. As he was going up by the way, some youths came out of the city and mocked him, and said to him, "Go up, you baldy! Go up, you baldy!" ²⁴He looked behind him and saw them, and cursed them in the LORD's name. Then two female bears came out of the woods and mauled forty-two of those youths. ²⁵He went from there to Mount Carmel, and from there he returned to Samaria.

3Now Jehoram the son of Ahab began to reign over Israel in Samaria in the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat king of Judah, and reigned twelve years. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, but not like his father and like his mother, for he put away the pillar of Baal that his father had made. ³Nevertheless he held to the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. He didn't depart from them. ⁴Now Mesha king of

Moab was a sheep breeder; and he supplied the king of Israel with one hundred thousand lambs and the wool of one hundred thousand rams. ⁵But when Ahab was dead, the king of Moab rebelled against the king of Israel. ⁶King Jehoram went out of Samaria at that time, and mustered all Israel. ⁷He went and sent to Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, saying, "The king of Moab has rebelled against me. Will you go with me against Moab to battle?" He said, "I will go up. I am as you are, my people as your people, my horses as your horses." ⁸Then he said, "Which way shall we go up?" Jehoram answered, "The way of the wilderness of Edom." ⁹So the king of Israel went with the king of Judah and the king of Edom, and they marched for seven days along a circuitous route. There was no water for the army or for the animals that followed them. ¹⁰The king of Israel said, "Alas! For the LORD has called these three kings together to deliver them into the hand of Moab." ¹¹But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there a prophet of the LORD here, that we may inquire of the LORD by him?" One of the king of Israel's servants answered, "Elisha the son of Shaphat, who poured water on the hands of Elijah, is here." ¹²Jehoshaphat said, "The LORD's word is with him." So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him. ¹³Elisha said to the king of Israel, "What have I to do with you? Go to the prophets of your father, and to the prophets of your mother." The king of Israel said to him, "No, for the LORD has called these three kings together to deliver them into the hand of Moab." ¹⁴Elisha said, "As the LORD of Hosts lives, before whom I stand, surely, were it not that I respect the presence of Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, I would not look toward you, nor see you." ¹⁵But now bring me a musician." When the musician played, the LORD's hand came on him. ¹⁶He said, "The LORD says, 'Make this valley full of trenches.'" ¹⁷For the LORD says, 'You will not see wind, neither will you see rain, yet that valley will be filled with water, and you will drink, both you and your livestock and your other animals. ¹⁸This is an easy thing in the LORD's sight. He will also deliver the Moabites into your hand. ¹⁹You shall strike every fortified city and every choice city, and shall fell every good tree, and stop all springs of water, and mar every good piece of land with stones.'" ²⁰In the morning, about the time of offering the sacrifice, behold, water came by the way of Edom, and the country was filled with water. ²¹Now when all the Moabites heard that the kings had come up to fight against them, they gathered themselves together, all who were able to put on armor, young and old, and stood on the border. ²²They rose up early in the morning, and the sun shone on the water, and the Moabites saw the water opposite them as red as blood. ²³They said, "This is blood. The kings are surely destroyed, and they have struck each other. Now therefore, Moab, to the plunder!" ²⁴When they came to the camp of Israel, the Israelites rose up and struck the Moabites,

so that they fled before them; and they went forward into the land attacking the Moabites. ²⁵They beat down the cities; and on every good piece of land each man cast his stone, and filled it. They also stopped all the springs of water and cut down all the good trees, until in Kir Hareseth all they left was its stones; however the men armed with slings went around it and attacked it. ²⁶When the king of Moab saw that the battle was too severe for him, he took with him seven hundred men who drew a sword, to break through to the king of Edom; but they could not. ²⁷Then he took his oldest son who would have reigned in his place, and offered him for a burnt offering on the wall. There was great wrath against Israel; and they departed from him, and returned to their own land.

⁴Now a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha, saying, "Your servant my husband is dead. You know that your servant feared the LORD. Now the creditor has come to take for himself my two children to be slaves." ²Elisha said to her, "What should I do for you? Tell me, what do you have in the house?" She said, "Your servant has nothing in the house, except a pot of oil." ³Then he said, "Go, borrow empty containers from all your neighbors. Don't borrow just a few containers. ⁴Go in and shut the door on you and on your sons, and pour oil into all those containers; and set aside those which are full." ⁵So she went from him, and shut the door on herself and on her sons. They brought the containers to her, and she poured oil. ⁶When the containers were full, she said to her son, "Bring me another container." He said to her, "There isn't another container." Then the oil stopped flowing. ⁷Then she came and told the man of God. He said, "Go, sell the oil, and pay your debt; and you and your sons live on the rest." ⁸One day Elisha went to Shunem, where there was a prominent woman; and she persuaded him to eat bread. So it was, that as often as he passed by, he turned in there to eat bread. ⁹She said to her husband, "See now, I perceive that this is a holy man of God who passes by us continually. ¹⁰Please, let's make a little room on the roof. Let's set a bed, a table, a chair, and a lamp stand for him there. When he comes to us, he can stay there." ¹¹One day he came there, and he went to the room and lay there. ¹²He said to Gehazi his servant, "Call this Shunammite." When he had called her, she stood before him. ¹³He said to him, "Say now to her, 'Behold, you have cared for us with all this care. What is to be done for you? Would you like to be spoken for to the king, or to the captain of the army?'" She answered, "I dwell among my own people." ¹⁴He said, "What then is to be done for her?" Gehazi answered, "Most certainly she has no son, and her husband is old." ¹⁵He said, "Call her." When he had called her, she stood in the door. ¹⁶He said, "At this season next year, you will embrace a son." She said, "No, my lord, my man of God, do not lie to your

servant." ¹⁷The woman conceived, and bore a son at that season when the time came around, as Elisha had said to her. ¹⁸When the child was grown, one day he went out to his father to the reapers. ¹⁹He said to his father, "My head! My head!" He said to his servant, "Carry him to his mother." ²⁰When he had taken him and brought him to his mother, he sat on her knees until noon, and then died. ²¹She went up and laid him on the man of God's bed, and shut the door on him, and went out. ²²She called to her husband and said, "Please send me one of the servants, and one of the donkeys, that I may run to the man of God and come again." ²³He said, "Why would you want go to him today? It is not a new moon or a Sabbath." She said, "It's all right." ²⁴Then she saddled a donkey, and said to her servant, "Drive, and go forward! Don't slow down for me, unless I ask you to." ²⁵So she went, and came to the man of God to Mount Carmel. When the man of God saw her afar off, he said to Gehazi his servant, "Behold, there is the Shunammite. ²⁶Please run now to meet her, and ask her, 'Is it well with you? Is it well with your husband? Is it well with your child?'" She answered, "It is well." ²⁷When she came to the man of God to the hill, she caught hold of his feet. Gehazi came near to thrust her away; but the man of God said, "Leave her alone, for her soul is troubled within her; and the LORD has hidden it from me, and has not told me." ²⁸Then she said, "Did I ask you for a son, my lord? Didn't I say, 'Do not deceive me?'" ²⁹Then he said to Gehazi, "Tuck your cloak into your belt, take my staff in your hand, and go your way. If you meet any man, don't greet him; and if anyone greets you, don't answer him again. Then lay my staff on the child's face." ³⁰The child's mother said, "As the LORD lives, and as your soul lives, I will not leave you." So he arose, and followed her. ³¹Gehazi went ahead of them, and laid the staff on the child's face; but there was no voice and no hearing. Therefore he returned to meet him, and told him, "The child has not awakened." ³²When Elisha had come into the house, behold, the child was dead, and lying on his bed. ³³He went in therefore, and shut the door on them both, and prayed to the LORD. ³⁴He went up and lay on the child, and put his mouth on his mouth, and his eyes on his eyes, and his hands on his hands. He stretched himself on him; and the child's flesh grew warm. ³⁵Then he returned, and walked in the house once back and forth, then went up and stretched himself out on him. Then the child sneezed seven times, and the child opened his eyes. ³⁶He called Gehazi, and said, "Call this Shunammite!" So he called her. When she had come in to him, he said, "Take up your son." ³⁷Then she went in, fell at his feet, and bowed herself to the ground; then she picked up her son, and went out. ³⁸Elisha came again to Gilgal. There was a famine in the land; and the sons of the prophets were sitting before him; and he said to his servant, "Get the large pot, and boil stew for the sons of the prophets." ³⁹One went out

into the field to gather herbs, and found a wild vine, and gathered a lap full of wild gourds from it, and came and cut them up into the pot of stew; for they didn't recognize them. ⁴⁰So they poured out for the men to eat. As they were eating some of the stew, they cried out and said, "Man of God, there is death in the pot!" And they could not eat it. ⁴¹But he said, "Then bring meal." He threw it into the pot; and he said, "Serve it to the people, that they may eat." And there was nothing harmful in the pot. ⁴²A man from Baal Shalishah came, and brought the man of God some bread of the first fruits: twenty loaves of barley and fresh ears of grain in his sack. Elisha said, "Give to the people, that they may eat." ⁴³His servant said, "What, should I set this before a hundred men?" But he said, "Give it to the people, that they may eat; for the LORD says, 'They will eat, and will have some left over.'" ⁴⁴So he set it before them and they ate and had some left over, according to the LORD's word.

⁵Now Naaman, captain of the army of the king of Syria, was a great man with his master, and honorable, because by him the LORD had given victory to Syria; he was also a mighty man of valor, but he was a leper. ²The Syrians had gone out in bands, and had brought away captive out of Eretz-Israel a little girl, and she waited on Naaman's wife. ³She said to her mistress, "I wish that my lord were with the prophet who is in Samaria! Then he would heal him of his leprosy." ⁴Someone went in and told his lord, saying, "The girl who is from Eretz-Israel said this." ⁵The king of Syria said, "Go now, and I will send a letter to the king of Israel." He departed, and took with him ten talents ^{iv} of silver, six thousand pieces of gold, and ten changes of clothing. ⁶He brought the letter to the king of Israel, saying, "Now when this letter has come to you, behold, I have sent Naaman my servant to you, that you may heal him of his leprosy." ⁷When the king of Israel had read the letter, he tore his clothes and said, "Am I God, to kill and to make alive, that this man sends to me to heal a man of his leprosy? But please consider and see how he seeks a quarrel against me." ⁸It was so, when Elisha the man of God heard that the king of Israel had torn his clothes, that he sent to the king, saying, "Why have you torn your clothes? Let him come now to me, and he shall know that there is a prophet in Israel." ⁹So Naaman came with his horses and with his chariots, and stood at the door of the house of Elisha. ¹⁰Elisha sent a messenger to him, saying, "Go and wash in the Jordan seven times, and your flesh shall come again to you, and you shall be clean." ¹¹But Naaman was angry, and went away and said, "Behold, I thought, 'He will surely come out to me, and stand, and call on the name of the LORD his God, and wave his hand over the place, and heal the leper.'" ¹²Aren't Abanah and Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, better than all the

waters of Israel? Couldn't I wash in them and be clean?" So he turned and went away in a rage. ¹³His servants came near and spoke to him, and said, "My father, if the prophet had asked you do some great thing, wouldn't you have done it? How much rather then, when he says to you, 'Wash, and be clean?'" ¹⁴Then went he down and dipped himself seven times in the Jordan, according to the saying of the man of God; and his flesh was restored like the flesh of a little child, and he was clean. ¹⁵He returned to the man of God, he and all his company, and came, and stood before him; and he said, "See now, I know that there is no God in all the earth, but in Israel. Now therefore, please take a gift from your servant." ¹⁶But he said, "As the LORD lives, before whom I stand, I will receive none." He urged him to take it; but he refused. ¹⁷Naaman said, "If not, then, please let two mules' load of earth be given to your servant; for your servant will from now on offer neither burnt offering nor sacrifice to other gods, but to the LORD." ¹⁸In this thing may the LORD pardon your servant: when my master goes into the house of Rimmon to worship there, and he leans on my hand, and I bow myself in the house of Rimmon. When I bow myself in the house of Rimmon, may the LORD pardon your servant in this thing." ¹⁹He said to him, "Go in peace." So he departed from him a little way. ²⁰But Gehazi the servant of Elisha the man of God, said, "Behold, my master has spared this Naaman the Syrian, in not receiving at his hands that which he brought. As the LORD lives, I will run after him, and take something from him." ²¹So Gehazi followed after Naaman. When Naaman saw one running after him, he came down from the chariot to meet him, and said, "Is all well?" ²²He said, "All is well. My master has sent me, saying, 'Behold, even now two young men of the sons of the prophets have come to me from the hill country of Ephraim. Please give them a talent ^v of silver and two changes of clothing.'" ²³Naaman said, "Be pleased to take two talents." He urged him, and bound two talents of silver in two bags, with two changes of clothing, and laid them on two of his servants; and they carried them before him. ²⁴When he came to the hill, he took them from their hand, and stored them in the house. Then he let the men go, and they departed. ²⁵But he went in, and stood before his master. Elisha said to him, "Where did you come from, Gehazi?" He said, "Your servant went nowhere." ²⁶He said to him, "Didn't my heart go with you when the man turned from his chariot to meet you? Is it a time to receive money, and to receive garments, and olive groves and vineyards, and sheep and cattle, and male servants and female servants?" ²⁷Therefore the leprosy of Naaman will cling to you and to your offspring ^{vi} forever." He went out from his presence a leper, as white as snow.

^vA talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{vi}or, seed

^{iv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

⁶The sons of the prophets said to Elisha, "See now, the place where we live and meet with you is too small for us. ²Please let us go to the Jordan, and each man take a beam from there, and let's make us a place there, where we may live." He answered, "Go!" ³One said, "Please be pleased to go with your servants." He answered, "I will go." ⁴So he went with them. When they came to the Jordan, they cut down wood. ⁵But as one was cutting down a tree, the ax head fell into the water. Then he cried out and said, "Alas, my master! For it was borrowed." ⁶The man of God asked, "Where did it fall?" He showed him the place. He cut down a stick, threw it in there, and made the iron float. ⁷He said, "Take it." So he put out his hand and took it. ⁸Now the king of Syria was at war against Israel; and he took counsel with his servants, saying, "My camp will be in such and such a place." ⁹The man of God sent to the king of Israel, saying, "Beware that you not pass this place, for the Syrians are coming down there." ¹⁰The king of Israel sent to the place which the man of God told him and warned him of; and he saved himself there, not once or twice. ¹¹The king of Syria's heart was very troubled about this. He called his servants, and said to them, "Won't you show me which of us is for the king of Israel?" ¹²One of his servants said, "No, my lord, O king; but Elisha, the prophet who is in Israel, tells the king of Israel the words that you speak in your bedroom." ¹³He said, "Go and see where he is, that I may send and get him." He was told, "Behold, he is in Dothan." ¹⁴Therefore he sent horses, chariots, and a great army there. They came by night and surrounded the city. ¹⁵When the servant of the man of God had risen early and gone out, behold, an army with horses and chariots was around the city. His servant said to him, "Alas, my master! What shall we do?" ¹⁶He answered, "Don't be afraid, for those who are with us are more than those who are with them." ¹⁷Elisha prayed, and said, "LORD, please open his eyes, that he may see." the LORD opened the young man's eyes, and he saw; and behold, the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire around Elisha. ¹⁸When they came down to him, Elisha prayed to the LORD, and said, "Please strike this people with blindness." He struck them with blindness according to Elisha's word. ¹⁹Elisha said to them, "This is not the way, neither is this the city. Follow me, and I will bring you to the man whom you seek." He led them to Samaria. ²⁰When they had come into Samaria, Elisha said, "LORD, open these men's eyes, that they may see." The LORD opened their eyes, and they saw; and behold, they were in the middle of Samaria. ²¹The king of Israel said to Elisha, when he saw them, "My father, shall I strike them? Shall I strike them?" ²²He answered, "You shall not strike them. Would you strike those whom you have taken captive with your sword and with your bow? Set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, then go to their master." ²³He prepared a great feast for them. After

they ate and drank, he sent them away and they went to their master. So the bands of Syria stopped raiding Eretz-Israel. ²⁴After this, Benhadad king of Syria gathered all his army, and went up and besieged Samaria. ²⁵There was a great famine in Samaria. Behold, they besieged it until a donkey's head was sold for eighty pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a kab ^{vii} of dove's dung for five pieces of silver. ²⁶As the king of Israel was passing by on the wall, a woman cried to him, saying, "Help, my lord, O king!" ²⁷He said, "If the LORD doesn't help you, where could I get help for you? From of the threshing floor, or from the wine press?" ²⁸Then the king asked her, "What is your problem?" She answered, "This woman said to me, 'Give your son, that we may eat him today, and we will eat my son tomorrow.' ²⁹So we boiled my son and ate him; and I said to her on the next day, 'Give up your son, that we may eat him;' and she has hidden her son." ³⁰When the king heard the words of the woman, he tore his clothes. Now he was passing by on the wall, and the people looked, and behold, he had sackcloth underneath on his body. ³¹Then he said, "God do so to me, and more also, if the head of Elisha the son of Shaphat stays on him today." ³²But Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. Then the king sent a man from before him; but before the messenger came to him, he said to the elders, "Do you see how this son of a murderer has sent to take away my head? Behold, when the messenger comes, shut the door, and hold the door shut against him. Isn't the sound of his master's feet behind him?" ³³While he was still talking with them, behold, the messenger came down to him. Then he said, "Behold, this evil is from the LORD. Why should I wait for the LORD any longer?"

⁷Elisha said, "Hear the LORD's word. The LORD says, 'Tomorrow about this time a seah ^{viii} of fine flour will be sold for a shekel, ^{ix} and two seahs of barley for a shekel, in the gate of Samaria.'" ²Then the captain on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God, and said, "Behold, if the LORD made windows in heaven, could this thing be?" He said, "Behold, you will see it with your eyes, but will not eat of it." ³Now there were four leprous men at the entrance of the gate. They said to one another, "Why do we sit here until we die? ⁴If we say, 'We will enter into the city,' then the famine is in the city, and we will die there. If we sit still here, we also die. Now therefore come, and let's surrender to the army of the Syrians. If they save us alive, we will live; and if they kill us, we will only die." ⁵They rose up in the twilight to go to the camp of the Syrians. When they had come to the outermost part of

^{vii}A kab was about 2 liters, so a fourth of a kab would be about 500 milliliters or about a pint

^{viii}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

^{ix}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

the camp of the Syrians, behold, no man was there. ⁶For the Lord ^x had made the army of the Syrians to hear the sound of chariots and the sound of horses, even the noise of a great army; and they said to one another, "Behold, the king of Israel has hired against us the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians to attack us." ⁷Therefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, their horses, and their donkeys, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life. ⁸When these lepers came to the outermost part of the camp, they went into one tent, and ate and drank, then carried away silver, gold, and clothing and went and hid it. Then they came back, and entered into another tent and carried things from there also, and went and hid them. ⁹Then they said to one another, "We aren't doing right. Today is a day of good news, and we keep silent. If we wait until the morning light, punishment will overtake us. Now therefore come, let's go and tell the king's household." ¹⁰So they came and called to the city gatekeepers; and they told them, "We came to the camp of the Syrians, and, behold, there was no man there, not even a man's voice, but the horses tied, and the donkeys tied, and the tents as they were." ¹¹Then the gatekeepers called out and told it to the king's household within. ¹²The king arose in the night, and said to his servants, "I will now show you what the Syrians have done to us. They know that we are hungry. Therefore they have gone out of the camp to hide themselves in the field, saying, 'When they come out of the city, we shall take them alive, and get into the city.'" ¹³One of his servants answered, "Please let some people take five of the horses that remain, which are left in the city. Behold, they are like all the multitude of Israel who are left in it. Behold, they are like all the multitude of Israel who are consumed. Let's send and see." ¹⁴Therefore they took two chariots with horses; and the king sent them out to the Syrian army, saying, "Go and see." ¹⁵They went after them to the Jordan; and behold, all the path was full of garments and equipment which the Syrians had cast away in their haste. The messengers returned and told the king. ¹⁶The people went out and plundered the camp of the Syrians. So a seah ^{xi} of fine flour was sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel, ^{xii} according to the LORD's word. ¹⁷The king had appointed the captain on whose hand he leaned to be in charge of the gate; and the people trampled over him in the gate, and he died as the man of God had said, who spoke when the king came down to him. ¹⁸It happened as the man of God had spoken to the king, saying, "Two seahs ^{xiii} of barley for a shekel, ^{xiv} and a seah of fine flour

for a shekel, shall be tomorrow about this time in the gate of Samaria;" ¹⁹and that captain answered the man of God, and said, "Now, behold, if the LORD made windows in heaven, might such a thing be?" and he said, "Behold, you will see it with your eyes, but will not eat of it." ²⁰It happened like that to him, for the people trampled over him in the gate, and he died.

⁸Now Elisha had spoken to the woman whose son he had restored to life, saying, "Arise, and go, you and your household, and stay for a while wherever you can; for the LORD has called for a famine. It will also come on the land for seven years." ²The woman arose, and did according to the man of God's word. She went with her household, and lived in the land of the Philistines for seven years. ³At the end of seven years, the woman returned from the land of the Philistines. Then she went out to beg the king for her house and for her land. ⁴Now the king was talking with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, "Please tell me all the great things that Elisha has done." ⁵As he was telling the king how he had restored to life him who was dead, behold, the woman whose son he had restored to life begged the king for her house and for her land. Gehazi said, "My lord, O king, this is the woman, and this is her son, whom Elisha restored to life." ⁶When the king asked the woman, she told him. So the king appointed to her a certain officer, saying, "Restore all that was hers, and all the fruits of the field since the day that she left the land, even until now." ⁷Elisha came to Damascus; and Benhadad the king of Syria was sick. He was told, "The man of God has come here." ⁸The king said to Hazael, "Take a present in your hand, and go meet the man of God, and inquire of the LORD by him, saying, 'Will I recover from this sickness?'" ⁹So Hazael went to meet him and took a present with him, even of every good thing of Damascus, forty camels' burden, and came and stood before him and said, "Your son Benhadad king of Syria has sent me to you, saying, 'Will I recover from this sickness?'" ¹⁰Elisha said to him, "Go, tell him, 'You will surely recover;' however the LORD has shown me that he will surely die." ¹¹He settled his gaze steadfastly on him, until he was ashamed. Then the man of God wept. ¹²Hazael said, "Why do you weep, my lord?" He answered, "Because I know the evil that you will do to the children of Israel. You will set their strongholds on fire, and you will kill their young men with the sword, and will dash their little ones in pieces, and rip up their pregnant women." ¹³Hazael said, "But what is your servant, who is but a dog, that he could do this great thing?" Elisha answered, "The LORD has shown me that you will be king over Syria." ¹⁴Then he departed from Elisha, and came to his master, who said to him, "What did Elisha say to you?" He answered, "He told me that you would surely recover." ¹⁵On the next day, he took a thick cloth, dipped it in water, and spread it on the king's

^xThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{xi}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

^{xii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

^{xiii}1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

^{xiv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

face, so that he died. Then Hazael reigned in his place. ¹⁶In the fifth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel, Jehoshaphat being king of Judah then, Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah began to reign. ¹⁷He was thirty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned eight years in Jerusalem. ¹⁸He walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as did Ahab's house, for he married Ahab's daughter. He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. ¹⁹However, the LORD would not destroy Judah, for David his servant's sake, as he promised him to give to him a lamp for his children always. ²⁰In his days Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah, and made a king over themselves. ²¹Then Joram crossed over to Zair, and all his chariots with him; and he rose up by night and struck the Edomites who surrounded him with the captains of the chariots; and the people fled to their tents. ²²So Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah to this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time. ²³The rest of the acts of Joram, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ²⁴Joram slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David's city; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place. ²⁵In the twelfth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel, Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah began to reign. ²⁶Ahaziah was twenty-two years old when he began to reign; and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Athaliah the daughter of Omri king of Israel. ²⁷He walked in the way of Ahab's house and did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, as did Ahab's house, for he was the son-in-law of Ahab's house. ²⁸He went with Joram the son of Ahab to war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth Gilead, and the Syrians wounded Joram. ²⁹King Joram returned to be healed in Jezreel from the wounds which the Syrians had given him at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, king of Judah, went down to see Joram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.

⁹Elisha the prophet called one of the sons of the prophets, and said to him, "Put your belt on your waist, take this vial of oil in your hand, and go to Ramoth Gilead. ²When you come there, find Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi, and go in and make him rise up from among his brothers, and take him to an inner room. ³Then take the vial of oil, and pour it on his head, and say, 'The LORD says, "I have anointed you king over Israel."' Then open the door, flee, and don't wait." ⁴So the young man, the young prophet, went to Ramoth Gilead. ⁵When he came, behold, the captains of the army were sitting. Then he said, "I have a message for you, captain." Jehu said, "To which one of us?" He said, "To you, O captain." ⁶He arose, and went into the house. Then he poured the oil on his head, and said to him, "The LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'I have anointed you king over the people of the LORD, even

over Israel. ⁷You must strike your master Ahab's house, that I may avenge the blood of my servants the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the LORD, at the hand of Jezebel. ⁸For the whole house of Ahab will perish. I will cut off from Ahab everyone who urinates against a wall, ^{xv} both him who is shut up and him who is left at large in Israel. ⁹I will make Ahab's house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah. ¹⁰The dogs will eat Jezebel on the plot of ground of Jezreel, and there shall be no one to bury her.'" Then he opened the door and fled. ¹¹When Jehu came out to the servants of his lord and one said to him, "Is all well? Why did this madman come to you?" He said to them, "You know the man and how he talks." ¹²They said, "That is a lie. Tell us now." He said, "He said to me, 'The LORD says, I have anointed you king over Israel.'" ¹³Then they hurried, and each man took his cloak, and put it under him on the top of the stairs, and blew the shofar, saying, "Jehu is king." ¹⁴So Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi conspired against Joram. (Now Joram was defending Ramoth Gilead, he and all Israel, because of Hazael king of Syria; ¹⁵but King Joram had returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the Syrians had given him when he fought with Hazael king of Syria.) Jehu said, "If this is your thinking, then let no one escape and go out of the city to go to tell it in Jezreel." ¹⁶So Jehu rode in a chariot and went to Jezreel, for Joram lay there. Ahaziah king of Judah had come down to see Joram. ¹⁷Now the watchman was standing on the tower in Jezreel, and he spied the company of Jehu as he came, and said, "I see a company." Joram said, "Take a horseman, and send to meet them, and let him say, 'Is it peace?'" ¹⁸So one went on horseback to meet him, and said, "the king says, 'Is it peace?'" Jehu said, "What do you have to do with peace? Fall in behind me!" The watchman said, "The messenger came to them, but he isn't coming back." ¹⁹Then he sent out a second on horseback, who came to them and said, "The king says, 'Is it peace?'" Jehu answered, "What do you have to do with peace? Fall in behind me!" ²⁰The watchman said, "He came to them, and isn't coming back. The driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi, for he drives furiously." ²¹Joram said, "Get ready!" They got his chariot ready. Then Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah went out, each in his chariot; and they went out to meet Jehu, and found him on Naboth the Jezreelite's land. ²²When Joram saw Jehu, he said, "Is it peace, Jehu?" He answered, "What peace, so long as the prostitution of your mother Jezebel and her witchcraft abound?" ²³Joram turned his hands and fled, and said to Ahaziah, "This is treason, Ahaziah!" ²⁴Jehu drew his bow with his full strength, and struck Joram between his arms; and the arrow went out at his heart, and he sunk down in his chariot. ²⁵Then Jehu said to Bidkar

^{xv}or, male

his captain, "Pick him up, and throw him in the plot of the field of Naboth the Jezreelite; for remember how, when you and I rode together after Ahab his father, the LORD laid this burden on him: ²⁶'Surely I have seen yesterday the blood of Naboth, and the blood of his sons,' says the LORD; 'and I will repay you in this plot of ground,' says the LORD. Now therefore take and cast him onto the plot of ground, according to the LORD's word." ²⁷But when Ahaziah the king of Judah saw this, he fled by the way of the garden house. Jehu followed after him, and said, "Strike him also in the chariot!" They struck him at the ascent of Gur, which is by Ibleam. He fled to Megiddo, and died there. ²⁸His servants carried him in a chariot to Jerusalem, and buried him in his tomb with his fathers in David's city. ²⁹In the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab, Ahaziah began to reign over Judah. ³⁰When Jehu had come to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it; and she painted her eyes, and adorned her head, and looked out at the window. ³¹As Jehu entered in at the gate, she said, "Do you come in peace, Zimri, you murderer of your master?" ³²He lifted up his face to the window, and said, "Who is on my side? Who?" Two or three eunuchs looked out at him. ³³He said, "Throw her down!" So they threw her down; and some of her blood was sprinkled on the wall, and on the horses. Then he trampled her under foot. ³⁴When he had come in, he ate and drank. Then he said, "See now to this cursed woman, and bury her; for she is a king's daughter." ³⁵They went to bury her, but they found no more of her than the skull, the feet, and the palms of her hands. ³⁶Therefore they came back, and told him. He said, "This is the LORD's word, which he spoke by his servant Elijah the Tishbite, saying, 'The dogs will eat the flesh of Jezebel on the plot of Jezreel,' ³⁷and the body of Jezebel will be as dung on the surface of the field on Jezreel's land, so that they won't say, 'This is Jezebel.'"

¹⁰Now Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. Jehu wrote letters and sent them to Samaria, to the rulers of Jezreel, even the elders, and to those who brought up Ahab's sons, saying, ²"Now as soon as this letter comes to you, since your master's sons are with you, and you have chariots and horses, a fortified city also, and armor, ³select the best and fittest of your master's sons, set him on his father's throne, and fight for your master's house." ⁴But they were exceedingly afraid, and said, "Behold, the two kings didn't stand before him! How then shall we stand?" ⁵He who was over the household, and he who was over the city, the elders also, and those who raised the children, sent to Jehu, saying, "We are your servants, and will do all that you ask us. We will not make any man king. You do that which is good in your eyes." ⁶Then he wrote a letter the second time to them, saying, "If you are on my side, and if you will listen to my voice, take the heads of the men who are your master's sons, and come to me to Jezreel by tomor-

row this time." Now the king's sons, being seventy persons, were with the great men of the city, who brought them up. ⁷When the letter came to them, they took the king's sons and killed them, even seventy people, and put their heads in baskets, and sent them to him to Jezreel. ⁸A messenger came and told him, "They have brought the heads of the king's sons." He said, "Lay them in two heaps at the entrance of the gate until the morning." ⁹In the morning, he went out and stood, and said to all the people, "You are righteous. Behold, I conspired against my master and killed him, but who killed all these?" ¹⁰Know now that nothing will fall to the earth of the LORD's word, which the LORD spoke concerning Ahab's house. For the LORD has done that which he spoke by his servant Elijah." ¹¹So Jehu struck all that remained of Ahab's house in Jezreel, with all his great men, his familiar friends, and his priests, until he left him no one remaining. ¹²He arose and departed, and went to Samaria. As he was at the shearing house of the shepherds on the way, ¹³Jehu met with the brothers of Ahaziah king of Judah, and said, "Who are you?" They answered, "We are the brothers of Ahaziah. We are going down to greet the children of the king and the children of the queen." ¹⁴He said, "Take them alive!" They took them alive, and killed them at the pit of the shearing house, even forty-two men. He didn't leave any of them. ¹⁵When he had departed from there, he met Jehonadab the son of Rechab coming to meet him. He greeted him, and said to him, "Is your heart right, as my heart is with your heart?" Jehonadab answered, "It is." "If it is, give me your hand." He gave him his hand; and he took him up to him into the chariot. ¹⁶He said, "Come with me, and see my zeal for the LORD." So they made him ride in his chariot. ¹⁷When he came to Samaria, he struck all who remained to Ahab in Samaria, until he had destroyed them, according to the LORD's word which he spoke to Elijah. ¹⁸Jehu gathered all the people together, and said to them, "Ahab served Baal a little, but Jehu will serve him much. ¹⁹Now therefore call to me all the prophets of Baal, all of his worshipers, and all of his priests. Let no one be absent, for I have a great sacrifice to Baal. Whoever is absent, he shall not live." But Jehu did deceptively, intending to destroy the worshipers of Baal. ²⁰Jehu said, "Sanctify a solemn assembly for Baal!" So they proclaimed it. ²¹Jehu sent through all Israel; and all the worshipers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left that didn't come. They came into the house of Baal; and the house of Baal was filled from one end to another. ²²He said to him who kept the wardrobe, "Bring out robes for all the worshipers of Baal!" So he brought robes out to them. ²³Jehu went with Jehonadab the son of Rechab into the house of Baal. Then he said to the worshipers of Baal, "Search, and see that none of the servants of the LORD are here with you, but only the worshipers of Baal." ²⁴So they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings. Now Jehu had ap-

pointed for himself eighty men outside, and said, "If any of the men whom I bring into your hands escape, he who lets him go, his life shall be for the life of him."²⁵ As soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, Jehu said to the guard and to the captains, "Go in and kill them! Let no one escape." So they struck them with the edge of the sword. The guard and the captains threw the bodies out, and went to the inner shrine of the house of Baal.²⁶ They brought out the pillars that were in the house of Baal and burned them. ²⁷They broke down the pillar of Baal, and broke down the house of Baal, and made it a latrine, to this day. ²⁸Thus Jehu destroyed Baal out of Israel. ²⁹However, Jehu didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin—the golden calves that were in Bethel and that were in Dan. ³⁰The LORD said to Jehu, "Because you have done well in executing that which is right in my eyes, and have done to Ahab's house according to all that was in my heart, your descendants shall sit on the throne of Israel to the fourth generation." ³¹But Jehu took no heed to walk in the law of the LORD, the God of Israel, with all his heart. He didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam, with which he made Israel to sin. ³²In those days the LORD began to cut away parts of Israel; and Hazael struck them in all the borders of Israel ³³from the Jordan eastward, all the land of Gilead, the Gadites, and the Reubenites, and the Manassites, from Aroer, which is by the valley of the Arnon, even Gilead and Bashan. ³⁴Now the rest of the acts of Jehu, and all that he did, and all his might, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ³⁵Jehu slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria. Jehoahaz his son reigned in his place. ³⁶The time that Jehu reigned over Israel in Samaria was twenty-eight years.

11 Now when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the royal offspring. ²But Jehosheba, the daughter of King Joram, sister of Ahaziah, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him away from among the king's sons who were slain, even him and his nurse, and put them in the bedroom; and they hid him from Athaliah, so that he was not slain. ³He was with her hidden in the LORD's house six years while Athaliah reigned over the land. ⁴In the seventh year Jehoiada sent and fetched the captains over hundreds of the Carites and of the guard, and brought them to him into the LORD's house; and he made a covenant with them, and made a covenant with them in the LORD's house, and showed them the king's son. ⁵He commanded them, saying, "This is what you must do: a third of you, who come in on the Sabbath, shall be keepers of the watch of the king's house; ⁶a third of you shall be at the gate Sur; and a third of you at the gate behind the guard. So you shall keep the watch of the house, and be a barrier. ⁷The

two companies of you, even all who go out on the Sabbath, shall keep the watch of the LORD's house around the king. ⁸You shall surround the king, every man with his weapons in his hand; and he who comes within the ranks, let him be slain. Be with the king when he goes out, and when he comes in." ⁹The captains over hundreds did according to all that Jehoiada the priest commanded; and they each took his men, those who were to come in on the Sabbath with those who were to go out on the Sabbath, and came to Jehoiada the priest. ¹⁰The priest delivered to the captains over hundreds the spears and shields that had been King David's, which were in the LORD's house. ¹¹The guard stood, every man with his weapons in his hand, from the right side of the house to the left side of the house, along by the altar and the house, around the king. ¹²Then he brought out the king's son, and put the crown on him, and gave him the covenant; and they made him king and anointed him; and they clapped their hands, and said, "Long live the king!" ¹³When Athaliah heard the noise of the guard and of the people, she came to the people into the LORD's house; ¹⁴and she looked, and behold, the king stood by the pillar, as the tradition was, with the captains and the shofars ^{xvi} or, trumpets by the king; and all the people of the land rejoiced, and blew shofars ^{xvii} . or, trumpets Then Athaliah tore her clothes and cried, "Treason! Treason!" ¹⁵Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains of hundreds who were set over the army, and said to them, "Bring her out between the ranks. Kill anyone who follows her with the sword." For the priest said, "Don't let her be slain in the LORD's house." ¹⁶So they seized her; and she went by the way of the horses' entry to the king's house, and she was slain there. ¹⁷Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people, that they should be the LORD's people; also between the king and the people. ¹⁸All the people of the land went to the house of Baal, and broke it down. They broke his altars and his images in pieces thoroughly, and killed Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars. The priest appointed officers over the LORD's house. ¹⁹He took the captains over hundreds, and the Carites, and the guard, and all the people of the land; and they brought down the king from the LORD's house, and came by the way of the gate of the guard to the king's house. He sat on the throne of the kings. ²⁰So all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet. They had slain Athaliah with the sword at the king's house. ²¹Jehoash was seven years old when he began to reign.

12 Jehoash began to reign in the seventh year of Jehu, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zibiah of Beersheba. ²Jehoash did that which was right in the LORD's eyes all his days in which Jehoiada

^{xvi}or, trumpets

^{xvii}or, trumpets.

the priest instructed him. ³However, the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places. ⁴Jehoash said to the priests, "All the money of the holy things that is brought into the LORD's house, in current money, the money of the people for whom each man is evaluated, and all the money that it comes into any man's heart to bring into the LORD's house, ⁵let the priests take it to them, each man from his donor; and they shall repair the damage to the house, wherever any damage is found." ⁶But it was so, that in the twenty-third year of King Jehoash the priests had not repaired the damage to the house. ⁷Then King Jehoash called for Jehoiada the priest, and for the other priests, and said to them, "Why aren't you repairing the damage to the house? Now therefore take no more money from your treasurers, but deliver it for repair of the damage to the house." ⁸The priests consented that they should take no more money from the people, and not repair the damage to the house. ⁹But Jehoiada the priest took a chest and bored a hole in its lid, and set it beside the altar, on the right side as one comes into the LORD's house; and the priests who kept the threshold put all the money that was brought into the LORD's house into it. ¹⁰When they saw that there was much money in the chest, the king's scribe and the high priest came up, and they put it in bags and counted the money that was found in the LORD's house. ¹¹They gave the money that was weighed out into the hands of those who did the work, who had the oversight of the LORD's house; and they paid it out to the carpenters and the builders who worked on the LORD's house, ¹²and to the masons and the stone cutters, and for buying timber and cut stone to repair the damage to the LORD's house, and for all that was laid out for the house to repair it. ¹³But there were not made for the LORD's house cups of silver, snuffers, basins, shofars ^{xviii}, or, trumpets; any vessels of gold or vessels of silver, of the money that was brought into the LORD's house; ¹⁴for they gave that to those who did the work, and repaired the LORD's house with it. ¹⁵Moreover they didn't demand an accounting from the men into whose hand they delivered the money to give to those who did the work; for they dealt faithfully. ¹⁶The money for the trespass offerings and the money for the sin offerings was not brought into the LORD's house. It was the priests'. ¹⁷Then Hazael king of Syria went up and fought against Gath, and took it; and Hazael set his face to go up to Jerusalem. ¹⁸Jehoash king of Judah took all the holy things that Jehoshaphat and Jehoram and Ahaziah, his fathers, kings of Judah, had dedicated, and his own holy things, and all the gold that was found in the treasures of the LORD's house, and of the king's house, and sent it to Hazael king of Syria; and he went away from Jerusalem. ¹⁹Now the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chron-

icles of the kings of Judah? ²⁰His servants arose and made a conspiracy, and struck Joash at the house of Millo, on the way that goes down to Silla. ²¹For Jozacar the son of Shimeath, and Jehozabad the son of Shomer, his servants, struck him, and he died; and they buried him with his fathers in David's city; and Amaziah his son reigned in his place.

13In the twenty-third year of Joash the son of Ahaziah, king of Judah, Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria for seventeen years. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, and followed the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. He didn't depart from it. ³The LORD's anger burned against Israel, and he delivered them into the hand of Hazael king of Syria, and into the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael, continually. ⁴Jehoahaz begged the LORD, and the LORD listened to him; for he saw the oppression of Israel, how the king of Syria oppressed them. ⁵(The LORD gave Israel a savior, so that they went out from under the hand of the Syrians; and the children of Israel lived in their tents as before. ⁶Nevertheless they didn't depart from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, with which he made Israel to sin, but walked in them; and the Asherah also remained in Samaria.) ⁷For he didn't leave to Jehoahaz of the people any more than fifty horsemen, and ten chariots, and ten thousand footmen; for the king of Syria destroyed them and made them like the dust in threshing. ⁸Now the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz, and all that he did, and his might, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ⁹Jehoahaz slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria; and Joash his son reigned in his place. ¹⁰In the thirty-seventh year of Joash king of Judah, Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz began to reign over Israel in Samaria for sixteen years. ¹¹He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. He didn't depart from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin; but he walked in them. ¹²Now the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, and his might with which he fought against Amaziah king of Judah, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ¹³Joash slept with his fathers; and Jeroboam sat on his throne. Joash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel. ¹⁴Now Elisha became sick with the illness of which he died; and Joash the king of Israel came down to him, and wept over him, and said, "My father, my father, the chariots of Israel and its horsemen!" ¹⁵Elisha said to him, "Take bow and arrows;" and he took bow and arrows for himself. ¹⁶He said to the king of Israel, "Put your hand on the bow;" and he put his hand on it. Elisha laid his hands on the king's hands. ¹⁷He said, "Open the window eastward;" and he opened it. Then Elisha said, "Shoot!" and he shot. He said, "The LORD's arrow of victory, even the arrow of victory over Syria; for you will strike the

^{xviii}or, trumpets,

Syrians in Aphek until you have consumed them.” ¹⁸He said, “Take the arrows;” and he took them. He said to the king of Israel, “Strike the ground;” and he struck three times, and stopped. ¹⁹The man of God was angry with him, and said, “You should have struck five or six times. Then you would have struck Syria until you had consumed it, but now you will strike Syria just three times.” ²⁰Elisha died, and they buried him. Now the bands of the Moabites invaded the land at the coming in of the year. ²¹As they were burying a man, behold, they saw a band of raiders; and they threw the man into Elisha’s tomb. As soon as the man touched Elisha’s bones, he revived, and stood up on his feet. ²²Hazael king of Syria oppressed Israel all the days of Jehoahaz. ²³But the LORD was gracious to them, and had compassion on them, and favored them because of his covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and would not destroy them and he didn’t cast them from his presence as yet. ²⁴Hazael king of Syria died; and Benhadad his son reigned in his place. ²⁵Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz took again out of the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael the cities which he had taken out of the hand of Jehoahaz his father by war. Joash struck him three times, and recovered the cities of Israel.

14In the second year of Joash, son of Joahaz, king of Israel, Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah began to reign. ²He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Jehoaddin of Jerusalem. ³He did that which was right in the LORD’s eyes, yet not like David his father. He did according to all that Joash his father had done. ⁴However the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places. ⁵As soon as the kingdom was established in his hand, he killed his servants who had slain the king his father, ⁶but the children of the murderers he didn’t put to death, according to that which is written in the scroll of the Torah of Moses, as the LORD commanded, saying, “The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, nor the children be put to death for the fathers; but every man shall die for his own sin.” ⁷He killed ten thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt, and took Sela by war, and called its name Joktheel, to this day. ⁸Then Amaziah sent messengers to Jehoash, the son of Jehoahaz son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, “Come, let’s look one another in the face.” ⁹Jehoash the king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, “The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, ‘Give your daughter to my son as wife.’ Then a wild animal that was in Lebanon passed by, and trampled down the thistle. ¹⁰You have indeed struck Edom, and your heart has lifted you up. Enjoy the glory of it, and stay at home; for why should you meddle to your harm, that you fall, even you, and Judah with you?” ¹¹But Amaziah would not listen. So

Jehoash king of Israel went up; and he and Amaziah king of Judah looked one another in the face at Beth Shemesh, which belongs to Judah. ¹²Judah was defeated by Israel; and each man fled to his tent. ¹³Jehoash king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Jehoash the son of Ahaziah, at Beth Shemesh and came to Jerusalem, then broke down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate, four hundred cubits. ^{xix} ¹⁴He took all the gold and silver and all the vessels that were found in the LORD’s house and in the treasures of the king’s house, the hostages also, and returned to Samaria. ¹⁵Now the rest of the acts of Jehoash which he did, and his might, and how he fought with Amaziah king of Judah, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ¹⁶Jehoash slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel; and Jeroboam his son reigned in his place. ¹⁷Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah lived after the death of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel, fifteen years. ¹⁸Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ¹⁹They made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem, and he fled to Lachish; but they sent after him to Lachish and killed him there. ²⁰They brought him on horses, and he was buried at Jerusalem with his fathers in David’s city. ²¹All the people of Judah took Azariah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king in the place of his father Amaziah. ²²He built Elath and restored it to Judah. After that the king slept with his fathers. ²³In the fifteenth year of Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah, Jeroboam the son of Joash king of Israel began to reign in Samaria for forty-one years. ²⁴He did that which was evil in the LORD’s sight. He didn’t depart from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. ²⁵He restored the border of Israel from the entrance of Hamath to the sea of the Arabah, according to the LORD, the God of Israel’s word, which he spoke by his servant Jonah the son of Amittai, the prophet, who was from Gath Hepher. ²⁶For the LORD saw the affliction of Israel, that it was very bitter for all, slave and free; and there was no helper for Israel. ²⁷The LORD didn’t say that he would blot out the name of Israel from under the sky; but he saved them by the hand of Jeroboam the son of Joash. ²⁸Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, and all that he did, and his might, how he fought, and how he recovered Damascus, and Hamath, which had belonged to Judah, for Israel, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ²⁹Jeroboam slept with his fathers, even with the kings of Israel; and Zechariah his son reigned in his place.

15In the twenty-seventh year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Azariah son of Amaziah king of Judah began to reign.

^{xix}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

²He was sixteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jecoliah of Jerusalem. ³He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, according to all that his father Amaziah had done. ⁴However, the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places. ⁵The LORD struck the king, so that he was a leper to the day of his death, and lived in a separate house. Jotham, the king's son, was over the household, judging the people of the land. ⁶Now the rest of the acts of Azariah, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ⁷Azariah slept with his fathers; and they buried him with his fathers in David's city; and Jotham his son reigned in his place. ⁸In the thirty-eighth year of Azariah king of Judah, Zechariah the son of Jeroboam reigned over Israel in Samaria six months. ⁹He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, as his fathers had done. He didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. ¹⁰Shallum the son of Jabesh conspired against him, and struck him before the people and killed him, and reigned in his place. ¹¹Now the rest of the acts of Zechariah, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel. ¹²This was the LORD's word which he spoke to Jehu, saying, "Your sons to the fourth generation shall sit on the throne of Israel." So it came to pass. ¹³Shallum the son of Jabesh began to reign in the thirty-ninth year of Uzziah king of Judah, and he reigned for a month in Samaria. ¹⁴Menahem the son of Gadi went up from Tirzah, came to Samaria, struck Shallum the son of Jabesh in Samaria, killed him, and reigned in his place. ¹⁵Now the rest of the acts of Shallum, and his conspiracy which he made, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel. ¹⁶Then Menahem attacked Tiphsah and all who were in it and its border areas, from Tirzah. He attacked it because they didn't open their gates to him, and he ripped up all their women who were with child. ¹⁷In the thirty ninth year of Azariah king of Judah, Menahem the son of Gadi began to reign over Israel for ten years in Samaria. ¹⁸He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. He didn't depart all his days from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. ¹⁹Pul the king of Assyria came against the land, and Menahem gave Pul one thousand talents^{xx} of silver, that his hand might be with him to confirm the kingdom in his hand. ²⁰Menahem exacted the money from Israel, even from all the mighty men of wealth, from each man fifty shekels^{xxi} of silver, to give to the king of Assyria. So the king of Assyria turned back, and didn't stay there in the land. ²¹Now the rest of the acts of Menahem, and all that

he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel? ²²Menahem slept with his fathers, and Pekahiah his son reigned in his place. ²³In the fiftieth year of Azariah king of Judah, Pekahiah the son of Menahem began to reign over Israel in Samaria for two years. ²⁴He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. He didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. ²⁵Pekah the son of Remaliah, his captain, conspired against him and attacked him in Samaria, in the fortress of the king's house, with Argob and Arie; and with him were fifty men of the Gileadites. He killed him, and reigned in his place. ²⁶Now the rest of the acts of Pekahiah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel. ²⁷In the fifty-second year of Azariah king of Judah, Pekah the son of Remaliah began to reign over Israel in Samaria for twenty years. ²⁸He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. He didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. ²⁹In the days of Pekah king of Israel, Tiglath Pileser king of Assyria came and took Ijon, Abel Beth Maacah, Janoah, Kedesh, Hazor, Gilead, and Galilee, all the land of Naphtali; and he carried them captive to Assyria. ³⁰Hoshea the son of Elah made a conspiracy against Pekah the son of Remaliah, attacked him, killed him, and reigned in his place, in the twentieth year of Jotham the son of Uzziah. ³¹Now the rest of the acts of Pekah, and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel. ³²In the second year of Pekah the son of Remaliah king of Israel, Jotham the son of Uzziah king of Judah began to reign. ³³He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jerusha the daughter of Zadok. ³⁴He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes. He did according to all that his father Uzziah had done. ³⁵However the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places. He built the upper gate of the LORD's house. ³⁶Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ³⁷In those days, the LORD began to send Rezin the king of Syria and Pekah the son of Remaliah against Judah. ³⁸Jotham slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in his father David's city; and Ahaz his son reigned in his place.

16In the seventeenth year of Pekah the son of Remaliah, Ahaz the son of Jotham king of Judah began to reign. ²Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. He didn't do that which was right in the LORD his God's eyes, like David his father. ³But he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, and even made his son to pass through the fire, according to the abominations of the nations whom the LORD cast

^{xx}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds, so 1000 talents is about 30 metric tons

^{xxi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 50 shekels was about 0.5 kilograms or 1.1 pounds.

out from before the children of Israel. ⁴He sacrificed and burned incense in the high places, on the hills, and under every green tree. ⁵Then Rezin king of Syria and Pekah son of Remaliah king of Israel came up to Jerusalem to wage war. They besieged Ahaz, but could not overcome him. ⁶At that time Rezin king of Syria recovered Elath to Syria, and drove the Jews from Elath; and the Syrians came to Elath, and lived there to this day. ⁷So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglath Pileser king of Assyria, saying, "I am your servant and your son. Come up and save me out of the hand of the king of Syria and out of the hand of the king of Israel, who rise up against me." ⁸Ahaz took the silver and gold that was found in the LORD's house, and in the treasures of the king's house, and sent it for a present to the king of Assyria. ⁹The king of Assyria listened to him; and the king of Assyria went up against Damascus and took it, and carried its people captive to Kir, and killed Rezin. ¹⁰King Ahaz went to Damascus to meet Tiglath Pileser king of Assyria, and saw the altar that was at Damascus; and King Ahaz sent to Urijah the priest a drawing of the altar and plans to build it. ¹¹Urijah the priest built an altar. According to all that King Ahaz had sent from Damascus, so Urijah the priest made it for the coming of King Ahaz from Damascus. ¹²When the king had come from Damascus, the king saw the altar; and the king came near to the altar, and offered on it. ¹³He burned his burnt offering and his meal offering, poured his drink offering, and sprinkled the blood of his peace offerings on the altar. ¹⁴The bronze altar, which was before the LORD, he brought from the front of the house, from between his altar and the LORD's house, and put it on the north side of his altar. ¹⁵King Ahaz commanded Urijah the priest, saying, "On the great altar burn the morning burnt offering, the evening meal offering, the king's burnt offering and his meal offering, with the burnt offering of all the people of the land, their meal offering, and their drink offerings; and sprinkle on it all the blood of the burnt offering, and all the blood of the sacrifice; but the bronze altar will be for me to inquire by." ¹⁶Urijah the priest did so, according to all that King Ahaz commanded. ¹⁷King Ahaz cut off the panels of the bases, and removed the basin from off them, and took down the sea from off the bronze oxen that were under it, and put it on a pavement of stone. ¹⁸He removed the covered way for the Sabbath that they had built in the house, and the king's outer entrance to the LORD's house, because of the king of Assyria. ¹⁹Now the rest of the acts of Ahaz which he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ²⁰Ahaz slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David's city; and Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.

17In the twelfth year of Ahaz king of Judah, Hoshea the son of Elah began to reign in Samaria over Israel for nine years. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's

sight, yet not as the kings of Israel who were before him. ³Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against him; and Hoshea became his servant, and brought him tribute. ⁴The king of Assyria discovered a conspiracy in Hoshea; for he had sent messengers to So king of Egypt, and offered no tribute to the king of Assyria, as he had done year by year. Therefore the king of Assyria seized him, and bound him in prison. ⁵Then the king of Assyria came up throughout all the land, went up to Samaria, and besieged it three years. ⁶In the ninth year of Hoshea the king of Assyria took Samaria and carried Israel away to Assyria, and placed them in Halah, and on the Habor, the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes. ⁷It was so because the children of Israel had sinned against the LORD their God, who brought them up out of the land of Egypt from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and had feared other gods, ⁸and walked in the statutes of the nations whom the LORD cast out from before the children of Israel, and of the kings of Israel, which they made. ⁹The children of Israel secretly did things that were not right against the LORD their God; and they built high places for themselves in all their cities, from the tower of the watchmen to the fortified city; ¹⁰and they set up for themselves pillars and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every green tree; ¹¹and there they burned incense in all the high places, as the nations whom the LORD carried away before them did; and they did wicked things to provoke the LORD to anger; ¹²and they served idols, of which the LORD had said to them, "You shall not do this thing." ¹³Yet the LORD testified to Israel and to Judah, by every prophet and every seer, saying, "Turn from your evil ways, and keep my commandments and my statutes, according to all the law which I commanded your fathers, and which I sent to you by my servants the prophets." ¹⁴Notwithstanding, they would not listen, but hardened their neck like the neck of their fathers who didn't believe in the LORD their God. ¹⁵They rejected his statutes and his covenant that he made with their fathers, and his testimonies which he testified to them; and they followed vanity, and became vain, and followed the nations that were around them, concerning whom the LORD had commanded them that they should not do like them. ¹⁶They abandoned all the commandments of the LORD their God, and made molten images for themselves, even two calves, and made an Asherah, and worshiped all the army of the sky, and served Baal. ¹⁷They caused their sons and their daughters to pass through the fire, used divination and enchantments, and sold themselves to do that which was evil in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger. ¹⁸Therefore the LORD was very angry with Israel, and removed them out of his sight. There was none left but the tribe of Judah only. ¹⁹Also Judah didn't keep the commandments of the LORD their God, but walked in the statutes of Israel which they made. ²⁰The LORD rejected all the offspring

of Israel, afflicted them, and delivered them into the hands of raiders, until he had cast them out of his sight. ²¹For he tore Israel from David's house; and they made Jeroboam the son of Nebat king; and Jeroboam drove Israel from following the LORD, and made them sin a great sin. ²²The children of Israel walked in all the sins of Jeroboam which he did; they didn't depart from them ²³until the LORD removed Israel out of his sight, as he said by all his servants the prophets. So Israel was carried away out of their own land to Assyria to this day. ²⁴The king of Assyria brought people from Babylon, from Cuthah, from Avva, and from Hamath and Sepharvaim, and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the children of Israel; and they possessed Samaria and lived in its cities. ²⁵So it was, at the beginning of their dwelling there, that they didn't fear the LORD. Therefore the LORD sent lions among them, which killed some of them. ²⁶Therefore they spoke to the king of Assyria, saying, "The nations which you have carried away and placed in the cities of Samaria don't know the law of the god of the land. Therefore he has sent lions among them; and behold, they kill them, because they don't know the law of the god of the land." ²⁷Then the king of Assyria commanded, saying, "Carry there one of the priests whom you brought from there; and let him ^{xxii} go and dwell there, and let him teach them the law of the god of the land." ²⁸So one of the priests whom they had carried away from Samaria came and lived in Bethel, and taught them how they should fear the LORD. ²⁹However every nation made gods of their own, and put them in the houses of the high places which the Samaritans had made, every nation in their cities in which they lived. ³⁰The men of Babylon made Succoth Benoth, and the men of Cuth made Nergal, and the men of Hamath made Ashima, ³¹and the Avvites made Nibhaz and Tartak; and the Sepharvites burned their children in the fire to Adrammelech and Anammelech, the gods of Sepharvaim. ³²So they feared the LORD, and also made from among themselves priests of the high places for themselves, who sacrificed for them in the houses of the high places. ³³They feared the LORD, and also served their own gods, after the ways of the nations from among whom they had been carried away. ³⁴To this day they do what they did before. They don't fear the LORD, and they do not follow the statutes, or the ordinances, or the law, or the commandment which the LORD commanded the children of Jacob, whom he named Israel; ³⁵with whom the LORD had made a covenant and commanded them, saying, "You shall not fear other gods, nor bow yourselves to them, nor serve them, nor sacrifice to them; ³⁶but you shall fear the LORD, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt with great power and with an outstretched arm, and you shall bow yourselves to him, and you shall sacrifice to him. ³⁷The statutes and the ordinances, and the law and the commandment which he wrote for you, you shall

observe to do forever more. You shall not fear other gods. ³⁸You shall not forget the covenant that I have made with you. You shall not fear other gods. ³⁹But you shall fear the LORD your God, and he will deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies." ⁴⁰However they didn't listen, but they did what they did before. ⁴¹So these nations feared the LORD, and also served their engraved images. Their children did likewise, and so did their children's children. They do as their fathers did to this day.

¹⁸Now in the third year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, Hezekiah the son of Ahaz king of Judah began to reign. ²He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abi the daughter of Zechariah. ³He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, according to all that David his father had done. ⁴He removed the high places, broke the pillars, and cut down the Asherah. He also broke in pieces the bronze serpent that Moses had made, because in those days the children of Israel burned incense to it; and he called it Nehushtan. ⁵He trusted in the LORD, the God of Israel, so that after him was no one like him among all the kings of Judah, nor among them that were before him. ⁶For he joined with the LORD. He didn't depart from following him, but kept his commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses. ⁷The LORD was with him. Wherever he went, he prospered. He rebelled against the king of Assyria, and didn't serve him. ⁸He struck the Philistines to Gaza and its borders, from the tower of the watchmen to the fortified city. ⁹In the fourth year of King Hezekiah, which was the seventh year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against Samaria and besieged it. ¹⁰At the end of three years they took it. In the sixth year of Hezekiah, which was the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel, Samaria was taken. ¹¹The king of Assyria carried Israel away to Assyria, and put them in Halah, and on the Habor, the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes, ¹²because they didn't obey the LORD their God's voice, but transgressed his covenant, even all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded, and would not hear it or do it. ¹³Now in the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the fortified cities of Judah and took them. ¹⁴Hezekiah king of Judah sent to the king of Assyria at Lachish, saying, "I have offended you. Withdraw from me. That which you put on me, I will bear." The king of Assyria appointed to Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents ^{xxiii} of gold. ¹⁵Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in the LORD's house and in the treasures of the king's house. ¹⁶At that time, Hezekiah cut off the gold from the doors of the LORD's temple, and from the pillars which Hezekiah king of Judah had overlaid, and

^{xxii}Hebrew:

^{xxiii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

gave it to the king of Assyria. ¹⁷The king of Assyria sent Tartan, Rabсарis, and Rabshakeh from Lachish to King Hezekiah with a great army to Jerusalem. They went up and came to Jerusalem. When they had come up, they came and stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the highway of the fuller's field. ¹⁸When they had called to the king, Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder came out to them. ¹⁹Rabshakeh said to them, "Say now to Hezekiah, 'The great king, the king of Assyria, says, "What confidence is this in which you trust?' ²⁰You say (but they are but vain words), 'There is counsel and strength for war.' Now on whom do you trust, that you have rebelled against me?' ²¹Now, behold, you trust in the staff of this bruised reed, even in Egypt. If a man leans on it, it will go into his hand and pierce it. So is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust on him. ²²But if you tell me, 'We trust in the LORD our God,' isn't that he whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah has taken away, and has said to Judah and to Jerusalem, 'You shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem?' ²³Now therefore, please give pledges to my master the king of Assyria, and I will give you two thousand horses if you are able on your part to set riders on them. ²⁴How then can you turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put your trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen? ²⁵Have I now come up without the LORD against this place to destroy it?' the LORD said to me, 'Go up against this land, and destroy it.'"²⁶Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, Shebna, and Joah, said to Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in the Syrian language, for we understand it. Don't speak with us in the Jews' language, in the hearing of the people who are on the wall." ²⁷But Rabshakeh said to them, "Has my master sent me to your master and to you, to speak these words? Hasn't he sent me to the men who sit on the wall, to eat their own dung, and to drink their own urine with you?" ²⁸Then Rabshakeh stood and cried with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and spoke, saying, "Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria. ²⁹The king says, 'Don't let Hezekiah deceive you, for he will not be able to deliver you out of his hand. ³⁰Don't let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, "The LORD will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria." ³¹Don't listen to Hezekiah.' For the king of Assyria says, 'Make your peace with me, and come out to me; and everyone of you eat from his own vine, and everyone from his own fig tree, and everyone drink water from his own cistern; ³²until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive trees and of honey, that you may live and not die. Don't listen to Hezekiah when he persuades you, saying, "The LORD will deliver us." ³³Has any of the gods of the nations ever delivered his

land out of the hand of the king of Assyria? ³⁴Where are the gods of Hamath and of Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah? Have they delivered Samaria out of my hand? ³⁵Who are they among all the gods of the countries, that have delivered their country out of my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?" ³⁶But the people stayed quiet, and answered him not a word; for the king's commandment was, "Don't answer him." ³⁷Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, came with Shebna the scribe and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder to Hezekiah with their clothes torn, and told him Rabshakeh's words.

¹⁹When King Hezekiah heard it, he tore his clothes, covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the LORD's house. ²He sent Eliakim, who was over the household, Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz. ³They said to him, "Hezekiah says, 'Today is a day of trouble, of rebuke, and of rejection; for the children have come to the point of birth, and there is no strength to deliver them. ⁴It may be the LORD your God will hear all the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master has sent to defy the living God, and will rebuke the words which the LORD your God has heard. Therefore lift up your prayer for the remnant that is left.'"⁵So the servants of King Hezekiah came to Isaiah. ⁶Isaiah said to them, "Tell your master this: 'The LORD says, "Don't be afraid of the words that you have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me. ⁷Behold, I will put a spirit in him, and he will hear news, and will return to his own land. I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.'"⁸So Rabshakeh returned and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah; for he had heard that he had departed from Lachish. ⁹When he heard it said of Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, "Behold, he has come out to fight against you," he sent messengers again to Hezekiah, saying, ¹⁰"Tell Hezekiah king of Judah this: 'Don't let your God in whom you trust deceive you, saying, Jerusalem will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria. ¹¹Behold, you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by destroying them utterly. Will you be delivered? ¹²Have the gods of the nations delivered them, which my fathers have destroyed—Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the children of Eden who were in Telassar? ¹³Where is the king of Hamath, the king of Arpad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah?"¹⁴Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers and read it. Then Hezekiah went up to the LORD's house, and spread it before the LORD. ¹⁵Hezekiah prayed before the LORD, and said, "LORD, the God of Israel, who are enthroned above the cherubim, you are the God, even you alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth. You have made heaven and earth. ¹⁶Incline your ear, LORD, and

hear. Open your eyes, LORD, and see. Hear the words of Sennacherib, which he has sent to defy the living God. ¹⁷Truly, LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste the nations and their lands, ¹⁸and have cast their gods into the fire; for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone. Therefore they have destroyed them. ¹⁹Now therefore, LORD our God, save us, I beg you, out of his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that you, LORD, are God alone." ²⁰Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, "The LORD, the God of Israel, says 'You have prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria, and I have heard you. ²¹This is the word that the LORD has spoken concerning him: 'The virgin daughter of Zion has despised you and ridiculed you. The daughter of Jerusalem has shaken her head at you. ²²Whom have you defied and blasphemed? Against whom have you exalted your voice and lifted up your eyes on high? Against the Holy One of Israel! ²³By your messengers, you have defied the Lord, and have said, "With the multitude of my chariots, I have come up to the height of the mountains, to the innermost parts of Lebanon, and I will cut down its tall cedars and its choice cypress trees; and I will enter into his farthest lodging place, the forest of his fruitful field. ²⁴I have dug and drunk strange waters, and I will dry up all the rivers of Egypt with the sole of my feet." ²⁵Haven't you heard how I have done it long ago, and formed it of ancient times? Now I have brought it to pass, that it should be yours to lay waste fortified cities into ruinous heaps. ²⁶Therefore their inhabitants had little power. They were dismayed and confounded. They were like the grass of the field and like the green herb, like the grass on the housetops and like grain blasted before it has grown up. ²⁷But I know your sitting down, your going out, your coming in, and your raging against me. ²⁸Because of your raging against me, and because your arrogance has come up into my ears, therefore I will put my hook in your nose, and my bridle in your lips, and I will turn you back by the way by which you came.' ²⁹"This will be the sign to you: This year, you will eat that which grows of itself, and in the second year that which springs from that; and in the third year sow and reap, and plant vineyards and eat their fruit. ³⁰The remnant that has escaped of the house of Judah will again take root downward, and bear fruit upward. ³¹For out of Jerusalem a remnant will go out, and out of Mount Zion those who shall escape. The LORD's zeal will perform this. ³²"Therefore the LORD says concerning the king of Assyria, 'He will not come to this city, nor shoot an arrow there. He will not come before it with shield, nor cast up a mound against it. ³³He will return the same way that he came, and he will not come to this city,' says the LORD. ³⁴'For I will defend this city to save it, for my own sake and for my servant David's sake.'" ³⁵That night, the LORD's angel went out and struck one hundred eighty-five thousand in the camp of the Assyrians. When men

arose early in the morning, behold, these were all dead bodies. ³⁶So Sennacherib king of Assyria departed, went home, and lived at Nineveh. ³⁷As he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, Adrammelech and Sharezer struck him with the sword; and they escaped into the land of Ararat. Esar Haddon his son reigned in his place.

20In those days Hezekiah was sick and dying. Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz came to him, and said to him, "The LORD says, 'Set your house in order; for you will die, and not live.'" ²Then he turned his face to the wall, and prayed to the LORD, saying, ³"Remember now, LORD, I beg you, how I have walked before you in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in your sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly. ⁴Before Isaiah had gone out into the middle part of the city, the LORD's word came to him, saying, ⁵"Turn back, and tell Hezekiah the prince of my people, 'The LORD, the God of David your father, says, "I have heard your prayer. I have seen your tears. Behold, I will heal you. On the third day, you will go up to the LORD's house. ⁶I will add to your days fifteen years. I will deliver you and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend this city for my own sake, and for my servant David's sake.'" ⁷Isaiah said, "Take a cake of figs." They took and laid it on the boil, and he recovered. ⁸Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "What will be the sign that the LORD will heal me, and that I will go up to the LORD's house the third day?" ⁹Isaiah said, "This will be the sign to you from the LORD, that the LORD will do the thing that he has spoken: should the shadow go forward ten steps, or go back ten steps?" ¹⁰Hezekiah answered, "It is a light thing for the shadow to go forward ten steps. No, but let the shadow return backward ten steps." ¹¹Isaiah the prophet cried to the LORD; and he brought the shadow ten steps backward, by which it had gone down on the sundial of Ahaz. ¹²At that time Berodach Baladan the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present to Hezekiah, for he had heard that Hezekiah had been sick. ¹³Hezekiah listened to them, and showed them all the storehouse of his precious things—the silver, the gold, the spices, and the precious oil, and the house of his armor, and all that was found in his treasures. There was nothing in his house, or in all his dominion, that Hezekiah didn't show them. ¹⁴Then Isaiah the prophet came to King Hezekiah, and said to him, "What did these men say? From where did they come to you?" Hezekiah said, "They have come from a far country, even from Babylon." ¹⁵He said, "What have they seen in your house?" Hezekiah answered, "They have seen all that is in my house. There is nothing among my treasures that I have not shown them." ¹⁶Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the LORD's word. ¹⁷'Behold, the days come that all that is in your house, and that which your fathers have laid up in store to this day, will be carried to

Babylon. Nothing will be left,' says the LORD. ¹⁸'They will take away some of your sons who will issue from you, whom you will father; and they will be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.'" ¹⁹Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "The LORD's word which you have spoken is good." He said moreover, "Isn't it so, if peace and truth will be in my days?" ²⁰Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and all his might, and how he made the pool, and the conduit, and brought water into the city, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ²¹Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and Manasseh his son reigned in his place.

21Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hephzibah. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, after the abominations of the nations whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel. ³For he built again the high places which Hezekiah his father had destroyed; and he raised up altars for Baal, and made an Asherah, as Ahab king of Israel did, and worshiped all the army of the sky, and served them. ⁴He built altars in the LORD's house, of which the LORD said, "I will put my name in Jerusalem." ⁵He built altars for all the army of the sky in the two courts of the LORD's house. ⁶He made his son to pass through the fire, practiced sorcery, used enchantments, and dealt with those who had familiar spirits and with wizards. He did much evil in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger. ⁷He set the engraved image of Asherah that he had made in the house of which the LORD said to David and to Solomon his son, "In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever; ⁸I will not cause the feet of Israel to wander any more out of the land which I gave their fathers, if only they will observe to do according to all that I have commanded them, and according to all the law that my servant Moses commanded them." ⁹But they didn't listen, and Manasseh seduced them to do that which is evil more than the nations did whom the LORD destroyed before the children of Israel. ¹⁰The LORD spoke by his servants the prophets, saying, ¹¹"Because Manasseh king of Judah has done these abominations, and has done wickedly above all that the Amorites did, who were before him, and has also made Judah to sin with his idols; ¹²therefore the LORD the God of Israel says, 'Behold, I will bring such evil on Jerusalem and Judah that whoever hears of it, both his ears will tingle. ¹³I will stretch over Jerusalem the line of Samaria, and the plumb line of Ahab's house; and I will wipe Jerusalem as a man wipes a dish, wiping it and turning it upside down. ¹⁴I will cast off the remnant of my inheritance and deliver them into the hands of their enemies. They will become a prey and a plunder to all their enemies, ¹⁵because they have done that which is evil in my

sight, and have provoked me to anger since the day their fathers came out of Egypt, even to this day.'" ¹⁶Moreover Manasseh shed innocent blood very much, until he had filled Jerusalem from one end to another; in addition to his sin with which he made Judah to sin, in doing that which was evil in the LORD's sight. ¹⁷Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and all that he did, and his sin that he sinned, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ¹⁸Manasseh slept with his fathers, and was buried in the garden of his own house, in the garden of Uzza; and Amon his son reigned in his place. ¹⁹Amon was twenty-two years old when he began to reign; and he reigned two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Meshullemeth the daughter of Haruz of Jotbah. ²⁰He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, as Manasseh his father did. ²¹He walked in all the ways that his father walked in, and served the idols that his father served, and worshiped them; ²²and he abandoned the LORD, the God of his fathers, and didn't walk in the way of the LORD. ²³The servants of Amon conspired against him, and put the king to death in his own house. ²⁴But the people of the land killed all those who had conspired against King Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his place. ²⁵Now the rest of the acts of Amon which he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ²⁶He was buried in his tomb in the garden of Uzza, and Josiah his son reigned in his place.

22Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jedidah the daughter of Adaiah of Bozkath. ²He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, and walked in all the way of David his father, and didn't turn away to the right hand or to the left. ³In the eighteenth year of King Josiah, the king sent Shaphan, the son of Azaliah the son of Meshullam, the scribe, to the LORD's house, saying, ⁴"Go up to Hilkiyah the high priest, that he may count the money which is brought into the LORD's house, which the keepers of the threshold have gathered of the people. ⁵Let them deliver it into the hand of the workers who have the oversight of the LORD's house; and let them give it to the workers who are in the LORD's house, to repair the damage to the house, ⁶to the carpenters, and to the builders, and to the masons, and for buying timber and cut stone to repair the house. ⁷However, no accounting shall be asked of them for the money delivered into their hand, for they deal faithfully." ⁸Hilkiyah the high priest said to Shaphan the scribe, "I have found the scroll of the Torah in the LORD's house." Hilkiyah delivered the book to Shaphan, and he read it. ⁹Shaphan the scribe came to the king, and brought the king word again, and said, "Your servants have emptied out the money that was found in the house, and have delivered it into the hands of the workmen who have the oversight of the LORD's house." ¹⁰Shaphan

the scribe told the king, saying, "Hilkiah the priest has delivered a book to me." Then Shaphan read it before the king. ¹¹When the king had heard the words of the scroll of the Torah, he tore his clothes. ¹²The king commanded Hilkiah the priest, Ahikam the son of Shaphan, Achbor the son of Micaiah, Shaphan the scribe, and Asaiah the king's servant, saying, ¹³"Go inquire of the LORD for me, and for the people, and for all Judah, concerning the words of this book that is found; for great is the LORD's wrath that is kindled against us, because our fathers have not listened to the words of this book, to do according to all that which is written concerning us." ¹⁴So Hilkiah the priest, Ahikam, Achbor, Shaphan, and Asaiah went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tikvah, the son of Harhas, keeper of the wardrobe (now she lived in Jerusalem in the second quarter); and they talked with her. ¹⁵She said to them, "The LORD the God of Israel says, 'Tell the man who sent you to me, ¹⁶'The LORD says, 'Behold, I will bring evil on this place and on its inhabitants, even all the words of the book which the king of Judah has read. ¹⁷Because they have forsaken me and have burned incense to other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the work of their hands, therefore my wrath shall be kindled against this place, and it will not be quenched.'" ¹⁸But to the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of The LORD, tell him, "the LORD the God of Israel says, 'Concerning the words which you have heard, ¹⁹because your heart was tender, and you humbled yourself before the LORD when you heard what I spoke against this place and against its inhabitants, that they should become a desolation and a curse, and have torn your clothes and wept before me, I also have heard you,' says the LORD. ²⁰Therefore behold, I will gather you to your fathers, and you will be gathered to your grave in peace. Your eyes will not see all the evil which I will bring on this place.'" So they brought this message back to the king.

23The king sent, and they gathered to him all the elders of Judah and of Jerusalem. ²The king went up to the LORD's house, and all the men of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him—with the priests, the prophets, and all the people, both small and great; and he read in their hearing all the words of the book of the covenant which was found in the LORD's house. ³The king stood by the pillar and made a covenant before the LORD to walk after the LORD and to keep his commandments, his testimonies, and his statutes with all his heart and all his soul, to confirm the words of this covenant that were written in this book; and all the people agreed to the covenant. ⁴The king commanded Hilkiah the high priest, and the priests of the second order, and the keepers of the threshold, to bring out of the LORD's temple all the vessels that were made for Baal, for the Asherah, and for all the

army of the sky; and he burned them outside of Jerusalem in the fields of the Kidron, and carried their ashes to Bethel. ⁵He got rid of the idolatrous priests whom the kings of Judah had ordained to burn incense in the high places in the cities of Judah and in the places around Jerusalem; those also who burned incense to Baal, to the sun, to the moon, to the planets, and to all the army of the sky. ⁶He brought out the Asherah from the LORD's house, outside of Jerusalem, to the brook Kidron, and burned it at the brook Kidron, and beat it to dust, and cast its dust on the graves of the common people. ⁷He broke down the houses of the male shrine prostitutes that were in the LORD's house, where the women wove hangings for the Asherah. ⁸He brought all the priests out of the cities of Judah, and defiled the high places where the priests had burned incense, from Geba to Beersheba; and he broke down the high places of the gates that were at the entrance of the gate of Joshua the governor of the city, which were on a man's left hand at the gate of the city. ⁹Nevertheless the priests of the high places didn't come up to the LORD's altar in Jerusalem, but they ate unleavened bread among their brothers. ¹⁰He defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the children of Hinnom, that no man might make his son or his daughter to pass through the fire to Molech. ¹¹He took away the horses that the kings of Judah had dedicated to the sun, at the entrance of the LORD's house, by the room of Nathan Melech the officer who was in the court; and he burned the chariots of the sun with fire. ¹²The king broke down the altars that were on the roof of the upper room of Ahaz, which the kings of Judah had made, and the altars which Manasseh had made in the two courts of the LORD's house, and beat them down from there, and cast their dust into the brook Kidron. ¹³The king defiled the high places that were before Jerusalem, which were on the right hand of the mountain of corruption, which Solomon the king of Israel had built for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Sidonians, and for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, and for Milcom the abomination of the children of Ammon. ¹⁴He broke in pieces the pillars, cut down the Asherah poles, and filled their places with men's bones. ¹⁵Moreover the altar that was at Bethel and the high place which Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, had made, even that altar and the high place he broke down; and he burned the high place and beat it to dust, and burned the Asherah. ¹⁶As Josiah turned himself, he spied the tombs that were there in the mountain; and he sent, and took the bones out of the tombs, and burned them on the altar, and defiled it, according to the LORD's word which the man of God proclaimed, who proclaimed these things. ¹⁷Then he said, "What monument is that which I see?" The men of the city told him, "It is the tomb of the man of God who came from Judah and proclaimed these things that you have done against the altar of Bethel." ¹⁸He said, "Let him be! Let no one move

his bones.” So they let his bones alone, with the bones of the prophet who came out of Samaria. ¹⁹All the houses also of the high places that were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke the LORD to anger, Josiah took away, and did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Bethel. ²⁰He killed all the priests of the high places that were there, on the altars, and burned men’s bones on them; and he returned to Jerusalem. ²¹The king commanded all the people, saying, “Keep the Passover to the LORD your God, as it is written in this book of the covenant.” ²²Surely there was not kept such a Passover from the days of the judges who judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, nor of the kings of Judah; ²³but in the eighteenth year of King Josiah, this Passover was kept to the LORD in Jerusalem. ²⁴Moreover, Josiah removed those who had familiar spirits, the wizards, and the teraphim, ^{xxiv} and the idols, and all the abominations that were seen in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, that he might confirm the words of the law which were written in the book that Hilkiah the priest found in the LORD’s house. ²⁵There was no king like him before him, who turned to the LORD with all his heart, and with all his soul, and with all his might, according to all the Torah of Moses; and there was none like him who arose after him. ²⁶Notwithstanding, the LORD didn’t turn from the fierceness of his great wrath, with which his anger burned against Judah, because of all the provocation with which Manasseh had provoked him. ²⁷The LORD said, “I will also remove Judah out of my sight, as I have removed Israel; and I will cast off this city which I have chosen, even Jerusalem, and the house of which I said, ‘My name shall be there.’” ²⁸Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and all that he did, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ²⁹In his days Pharaoh Necoh king of Egypt went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates; and King Josiah went against him, but Pharaoh Necoh killed him at Megiddo when he saw him. ³⁰His servants carried him dead in a chariot from Megiddo, brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own tomb. The people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and anointed him, and made him king in his father’s place. ³¹Jehoahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah. ³²He did that which was evil in the LORD’s sight, according to all that his fathers had done. ³³Pharaoh Necoh put him in bonds at Riblah in the land of Hamath, that he might not reign in Jerusalem; and put the land to a tribute of one hundred talents of silver and a talent ^{xxv} of gold. ³⁴Pharaoh Necoh made Eliakim the son of Josiah king in the place of Josiah his father, and changed his name to Jehoiakim; but he took Jehoahaz

away, and he came to Egypt and died there. ³⁵Jehoiakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; but he taxed the land to give the money according to the commandment of Pharaoh. He exacted the silver and the gold of the people of the land, from everyone according to his assessment, to give it to Pharaoh Necoh. ³⁶Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Zebidah the daughter of Pedaiah of Rumah. ³⁷He did that which was evil in the LORD’s sight, according to all that his fathers had done.

24In his days Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up, and Jehoiakim became his servant three years. Then he turned and rebelled against him. ²The LORD sent against him bands of the Kasdim, bands of the Syrians, bands of the Moabites, and bands of the children of Ammon, and sent them against Judah to destroy it, according to the LORD’s word which he spoke by his servants the prophets. ³Surely at the commandment of the LORD this came on Judah, to remove them out of his sight for the sins of Manasseh, according to all that he did, ⁴and also for the innocent blood that he shed; for he filled Jerusalem with innocent blood, and the LORD would not pardon. ⁵Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and all that he did, aren’t they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? ⁶So Jehoiakim slept with his fathers, and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place. ⁷The king of Egypt didn’t come out of his land any more; for the king of Babylon had taken, from the brook of Egypt to the river Euphrates, all that belonged to the king of Egypt. ⁸Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. His mother’s name was Nehushta the daughter of Elnathan of Jerusalem. ⁹He did that which was evil in the LORD’s sight, according to all that his father had done. ¹⁰At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up to Jerusalem, and the city was besieged. ¹¹Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to the city while his servants were besieging it, ¹²and Jehoiachin the king of Judah went out to the king of Babylon—he, his mother, his servants, his princes, and his officers; and the king of Babylon captured him in the eighth year of his reign. ¹³He carried out from there all the treasures of the LORD’s house and the treasures of the king’s house, and cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon king of Israel had made in the LORD’s temple, as the LORD had said. ¹⁴He carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the mighty men of valor, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and the smiths. No one remained except the poorest people of the land. ¹⁵He carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, with the king’s mother, the king’s wives, his officers, and the chief men of the land. He carried them into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon. ¹⁶All the men of might, even seven thousand,

^{xxiv}teraphim were household idols.

^{xxv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

and the craftsmen and the smiths one thousand, all of them strong and fit for war, even them the king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon. ¹⁷The king of Babylon made Mattaniah, Jehoiachin's father's brother, king in his place, and changed his name to Zedekiah. ¹⁸Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah. ¹⁹He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, according to all that Jehoiakim had done. ²⁰For through the anger of the LORD, this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence. Then Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

25In the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and encamped against it; and they built forts against it around it. ²So the city was besieged until the eleventh year of King Zedekiah. ³On the ninth day of the fourth month, the famine was severe in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land. ⁴Then a breach was made in the city, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden (now the Kasdim were against the city around it); and the king went by the way of the Arabah. ⁵But the Chaldean army pursued the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him. ⁶Then they captured the king and carried him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah; and they passed judgment on him. ⁷They killed Zedekiah's sons before his eyes, then put out Zedekiah's eyes, bound him in fetters, and carried him to Babylon. ⁸Now in the fifth month, on the seventh day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem. ⁹He burned the LORD's house, the king's house, and all the houses of Jerusalem. He burned every great house with fire. ¹⁰All the army of the Kasdim, who were with the captain of the guard, broke down the walls around Jerusalem. ¹¹Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive the rest of the people who were left in the city and those who had deserted to the king of Babylon—all the rest of the multitude. ¹²But the captain of the guard left some of the poorest of the land to work the vineyards and fields. ¹³The Kasdim broke up the pillars of bronze that were in the LORD's house and the bases and the bronze sea that were in the LORD's house, and carried the bronze pieces to Babylon. ¹⁴They took away the pots, the shovels, the snuffers, the spoons, and all the vessels of bronze with which they ministered. ¹⁵The captain of the guard took away the fire pans, the basins, that which was of gold, for gold, and that which was of silver, for silver. ¹⁶The two pillars, the one sea, and the bases, which

Solomon had made for the LORD's house, the bronze of all these vessels was not weighed. ¹⁷The height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits, ^{xxvi} and a capital of bronze was on it. The height of the capital was three cubits, with network and pomegranates on the capital around it, all of bronze; and the second pillar with its network was like these. ¹⁸The captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the threshold; ¹⁹and out of the city he took an officer who was set over the men of war; and five men of those who saw the king's face, who were found in the city; and the scribe, the captain of the army, who mustered the people of the land, and sixty men of the people of the land who were found in the city. ²⁰Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard took them, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah. ²¹The king of Babylon attacked them and put them to death at Riblah in the land of Hamath. So Judah was carried away captive out of his land. ²²As for the people who were left in the land of Judah whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had left, even over them he made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, governor. ²³Now when all the captains of the forces, they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah governor, they came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, Yochanan the son of Kareah, Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth the Netophathite, and Jaazaniah the son of the Maacathite, they and their men. ²⁴Gedaliah swore to them and to their men, and said to them, "Don't be afraid because of the servants of the Kasdim. Dwell in the land and serve the king of Babylon, and it will be well with you." ²⁵But in the seventh month, Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of the royal offspring came, and ten men with him, and struck Gedaliah so that he died, with the Jews and the Kasdim that were with him at Mizpah. ²⁶All the people, both small and great, and the captains of the forces arose and came to Egypt; for they were afraid of the Kasdim. ²⁷In the thirty-seventh year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month, Evilmerodach king of Babylon, in the year that he began to reign, released Jehoiachin king of Judah out of prison, ²⁸and he spoke kindly to him and set his throne above the throne of the kings who were with him in Babylon, ²⁹and changed his prison garments. Jehoiachin ate bread before him continually all the days of his life; ³⁰and for his allowance, there was a continual allowance given him from the king, every day a portion, all the days of his life.

^{xxvi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

1 Chronicles

¹Adam, Seth, Enosh, ²Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, ³Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech, ⁴Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth. ⁵The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras. ⁶The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Diphath, and Togarmah. ⁷The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Rodanim. ⁸The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan. ⁹The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raama, Sabteca. The sons of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan. ¹⁰Cush became the father of Nimrod. He began to be a mighty one in the earth. ¹¹Mizraim became the father of Ludim, Anamim, Lehabim, Naphtuhim, ¹²Pathrusim, Casluhim (where the Philistines came from), and Caph-torim. ¹³Canaan became the father of Sidon his first-born, Heth, ¹⁴the Jebusite, the Amorite, the Girgashite, ¹⁵the Hivite, the Arkite, the Sinite, ¹⁶the Arvadite, the Zemarite, and the Hamathite. ¹⁷The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arpachshad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech. ¹⁸Arpachshad became the father of Shelah, and Shelah became the father of Eber. ¹⁹To Eber were born two sons: the name of the one was Peleg, for in his days the earth was divided; and his brother's name was Joktan. ²⁰Joktan became the father of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah, ²¹Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah, ²²Ebal, Abimael, Sheba, ²³Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan. ²⁴Shem, Arpachshad, Shelah, ²⁵Eber, Peleg, Reu, ²⁶Serug, Nahor, Terah, ²⁷Abram (also called Abraham). ²⁸The sons of Abraham: Isaac and Ishmael. ²⁹These are their generations: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebaioth; then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, ³⁰Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, Tema, ³¹Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemai. These are the sons of Ishmael. ³²The sons of Keturah, Abraham's concubine: she bore Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. The sons of Jokshan: Sheba and Dedan. ³³The sons of Midian: Efah, Ephraim, Hanoah, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the sons of Keturah. ³⁴Abraham became the father of Isaac. The sons of Isaac: Esau and Israel. ³⁵The sons of Esau: Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah. ³⁶The sons of Eliphaz: Teman, Omar, Zephi, Gatam, Kenaz, Timna, and Amalek. ³⁷The sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. ³⁸The sons of Seir: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. ³⁹The sons of Lotan: Hori and Homam;

and Timna was Lotan's sister. ⁴⁰The sons of Shobal: Alian, Manahath, Ebal, Shephi, and Onam. The sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah. ⁴¹The son of Anah: Dishon. The sons of Dishon: Hamran, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran. ⁴²The sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Jaakan. The sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran. ⁴³Now these are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom, before any king reigned over the children of Israel: Bela the son of Beor; and the name of his city was Dinhabah. ⁴⁴Bela died, and Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his place. ⁴⁵Jobab died, and Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his place. ⁴⁶Husham died, and Hadad the son of Bedad, who struck Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his place; and the name of his city was Avith. ⁴⁷Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his place. ⁴⁸Samlah died, and Shaul of Rehoboth by the River reigned in his place. ⁴⁹Shaul died, and Baal Hanan the son of Achbor reigned in his place. ⁵⁰Baal Hanan died, and Hadad reigned in his place; and the name of his city was Pai. His wife's name was Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the daughter of Mezahab. ⁵¹Then Hadad died. The chiefs of Edom were: chief Timna, chief Aliah, chief Jetheth, ⁵²chief Oholibamah, chief Elah, chief Pinon, ⁵³chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief Mibzar, ⁵⁴chief Magdiel, and chief Iram. These are the chiefs of Edom.

2These are the sons of Israel: Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, ²Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naph-tali, Gad, and Asher. ³The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, and Shelah, which three were born to him of Shua's daughter the Canaanitess. Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in the LORD's ⁱ sight; and he killed him. ⁴Tamar his daughter-in-law bore him Perez and Zerah. All the sons of Judah were five. ⁵The sons of Perez: Hezron and Hamul. ⁶The sons of Zerah: Zimri, Ethan, Heman, Calcol, and Dara—five of them in all. ⁷The son of Carmi: Achar, the troubler of Israel, who committed a trespass in the devoted thing. ⁸The son of Ethan: Azariah. ⁹The sons also of Hezron, who were born to him: Jerahmeel, Ram, and Chelubai. ¹⁰Ram became the father of Amminadab, and Amminadab became the father of Nahshon, prince of the

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

children of Judah; ¹¹and Nahshon became the father of Salma, and Salma became the father of Boaz, ¹²and Boaz became the father of Obed, and Obed became the father of Jesse; ¹³and Jesse became the father of his firstborn Eliab, Abinadab the second, Shimea the third, ¹⁴Nethanel the fourth, Raddai the fifth, ¹⁵Ozem the sixth, and David the seventh; ¹⁶and their sisters were Zeruiah and Abigail. The sons of Zeruiah: Abishai, Joab, and Asahel, three. ¹⁷Abigail bore Amasa; and the father of Amasa was Jether the Ishmaelite. ¹⁸Caleb the son of Hezron became the father of children by Azubah his wife, and by Jerioth; and these were her sons: Jesher, Shobab, and Ardun. ¹⁹Azubah died, and Caleb married Ephrath, who bore him Hur. ²⁰Hur became the father of Uri, and Uri became the father of Bezalel. ²¹Afterward Hezron went in to the daughter of Machir the father of Gilead, whom he took as wife when he was sixty years old; and she bore him Segub. ²²Segub became the father of Jair, who had twenty-three cities in the land of Gilead. ²³Geshur and Aram took the towns of Jair from them, with Kenath, and its villages, even sixty cities. All these were the sons of Machir the father of Gilead. ²⁴After Hezron died in Caleb Ephrathah, Abijah, Hezron's wife, bore him Ashhur the father of Tekoa. ²⁵The sons of Jerahmeel the firstborn of Hezron were Ram the firstborn, Bunah, Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah. ²⁶Jerahmeel had another wife, whose name was Atarah. She was the mother of Onam. ²⁷The sons of Ram the firstborn of Jerahmeel were Maaz, Jamin, and Eker. ²⁸The sons of Onam were Shammai and Jada. The sons of Shammai: Nadab and Abishur. ²⁹The name of the wife of Abishur was Abihail; and she bore him Ahban and Molid. ³⁰The sons of Nadab: Seled and Appaim; but Seled died without children. ³¹The son of Appaim: Ishi. The son of Ishi: Sheshan. The son of Sheshan: Ahlai. ³²The sons of Jada the brother of Shammai: Jether and Jonathan; and Jether died without children. ³³The sons of Jonathan: Peleth and Zaza. These were the sons of Jerahmeel. ³⁴Now Sheshan had no sons, but only daughters. Sheshan had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Jarha. ³⁵Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha his servant as wife; and she bore him Attai. ³⁶Attai became the father of Nathan, and Nathan became the father of Zabad, ³⁷and Zabad became the father of Ephlail, and Ephlail became the father of Obed, ³⁸and Obed became the father of Jehu, and Jehu became the father of Azariah, ³⁹and Azariah became the father of Helez, and Helez became the father of Eleasah, ⁴⁰and Eleasah became the father of Sismai, and Sismai became the father of Shallum, ⁴¹and Shallum became the father of Jekamiah, and Jekamiah became the father of Elishama. ⁴²The sons of Caleb the brother of Jerahmeel were Mesha his firstborn, who was the father of Ziph, and the sons of Mareshah the father of Hebron. ⁴³The sons of Hebron: Korah, Tappuah, Rekem, and Shema. ⁴⁴Shema became the father of Raham, the

father of Jorkeam; and Rekem became the father of Shammai. ⁴⁵The son of Shammai was Maon; and Maon was the father of Beth Zur. ⁴⁶Efah, Caleb's concubine, bore Haran, Moza, and Gazez; and Haran became the father of Gazez. ⁴⁷The sons of Jahdai: Regem, Jothan, Geshan, Pelet, Efah, and Shaaph. ⁴⁸Maacah, Caleb's concubine, bore Sheber and Tirhanah. ⁴⁹She bore also Shaaph the father of Madmannah, Sheva the father of Machbena and the father of Gibeaz; and the daughter of Caleb was Achsah. ⁵⁰These were the sons of Caleb, the son of Hur, the firstborn of Ephrathah: Shobal the father of Kiriath Jearim, ⁵¹Salma the father of Bethlehem, and Hareph the father of Beth Gader. ⁵²Shobal the father of Kiriath Jearim had sons: Haroeh, half of the Menuhoth. ⁵³The families of Kiriath Jearim: the Ithrites, the Puthites, the Shumathites, and the Mishraitites; from them came the Zorathites and the Eshtaulites. ⁵⁴The sons of Salma: Bethlehem, the Netophathites, Atroth Beth Joab, and half of the Manahathites, the Zorites. ⁵⁵The families of scribes who lived at Jabez: the Tirathites, the Shimeathites, and the Succathites. These are the Kenites who came from Hammath, the father of the house of Rechab.

3Now these were the sons of David, who were born to him in Hebron: the firstborn, Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; the second, Daniel, of Abigail the Carmelitess; ²the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur; the fourth, Adonijah the son of Hagith; ³the fifth, Shephatiah of Abital; the sixth, Ithream by Eglah his wife: ⁴six were born to him in Hebron; and he reigned there seven years and six months. He reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem; ⁵and these were born to him in Jerusalem: Shimea, Shobab, Nathan, and Solomon, four, by Bathshua the daughter of Ammiel; ⁶and Ithar, Elishama, Eliphelet, ⁷Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, ⁸Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet, nine. ⁹All these were the sons of David, in addition to the sons of the concubines; and Tamar was their sister. ¹⁰Solomon's son was Rehoboam, Abijah his son, Asa his son, Jehoshaphat his son, ¹¹Joram his son, Ahaziah his son, Joash his son, ¹²Amaziah his son, Azariah his son, Jotham his son, ¹³Ahaz his son, Hezekiah his son, Manasseh his son, ¹⁴Amon his son, and Josiah his son. ¹⁵The sons of Josiah: the firstborn Yochanan, the second Jehoiakim, the third Zedekiah, and the fourth Shallum. ¹⁶The sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his son, and Zedekiah his son. ¹⁷The sons of Jeconiah, the captive: Shealtiel his son, ¹⁸Malchiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar, Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah. ¹⁹The sons of Pedaiah: Zerubbabel and Shimei. The sons of Zerubbabel: Meshullam and Hananiah; and Shelomith was their sister; ²⁰and Hashubah, Ohel, Berechiah, Hasadiah, and Jushab Hesed, five. ²¹The sons of Hananiah: Pelatiah and Jeshaiah; the sons of Rephaiah, the sons of Arnan, the sons of Obadiah, the sons of Shecaniah. ²²The son of Shecaniah: Shemaiah. The

sons of Shemaiah: Hattush, Igal, Bariah, Neariah, and Shaphat, six. ²³The sons of Neariah: Elioenai, Hizkiah, and Azrikam, three. ²⁴The sons of Elioenai: Hodaviah, Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Yochanan, Delaiah, and Anani, seven.

⁴The sons of Judah: Perez, Hezron, Carmi, Hur, and Shobal. ²Reaiah the son of Shobal became the father of Jahath; and Jahath became the father of Ahumai and Lahad. These are the families of the Zorathites. ³These were the sons of the father of Etam: Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash. The name of their sister was Hazzelelponi. ⁴Penuel was the father of Gedor and Ezer the father of Hushah. These are the sons of Hur, the firstborn of Ephrathah, the father of Bethlehem. ⁵Ashhur the father of Tekoa had two wives, Helah and Naarah. ⁶Naarah bore him Ahuzzam, Hopher, Temeni, and Haahashtari. These were the sons of Naarah. ⁷The sons of Helah were Zereth, Izhar, and Ethnan. ⁸Hakkoz became the father of Anub, Zobebah, and the families of Aharhel the son of Harum. ⁹Jabez was more honorable than his brothers. His mother named him Jabez, ⁱⁱ saying, "Because I bore him with sorrow." ¹⁰Jabez called on the God ⁱⁱⁱ of Israel, saying, "Oh that you would bless me indeed, and enlarge my border! May your hand be with me, and may you keep me from evil, that I may not cause pain!" God granted him that which he requested. ¹¹Chelub the brother of Shuhah became the father of Mehir, who was the father of Eshton. ¹²Eshton became the father of Beth Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah the father of Ir Nahash. These are the men of Recah. ¹³The sons of Kenaz: Othniel and Seraiah. The sons of Othniel: Hathath. ^{iv} ¹⁴Meonothai became the father of Ophrah: and Seraiah became the father of Joab the father of Ge Harashim, for they were craftsmen. ¹⁵The sons of Caleb the son of Jephunneh: Iru, Elah, and Naam. The son of Elah: Kenaz. ¹⁶The sons of Jehallelel: Ziph, Ziphah, Tiria, and Asarel. ¹⁷The sons of Ezra: Jether, Mered, Ephraim, and Jalon; and Mered's wife bore Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah the father of Eshtemoa. ¹⁸His wife Yehudiyah bore Jered the father of Gedor, Heber the father of Soco, and Jekuthiel the father of Zanoah. These are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of Pharaoh, whom Mered took. ¹⁹The sons of the wife of Hodiah, the sister of Naham, were the fathers of Keilah the Garmite and Eshtemoa the Maacathite. ²⁰The sons of Shimon: Amnon, Rinnah, Ben Hanan, and Tilon. The sons of Ishi: Zoheth, and Ben Zoheth. ²¹The sons of Shelah the son of Judah: Er the father of Lecah, Laadah the father of Mareshah, and the families of the house of those who worked fine linen, of the house of Ashbea; ²²and Jokim, and the men of Cozeba, and Joash, and Saraph, who had dominion in Moab, and

Jashubilehem. These records are ancient. ²³These were the potters, and the inhabitants of Netaim and Gederah; they lived there with the king for his work. ²⁴The sons of Simeon: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, Shaul; ²⁵Shallum his son, Mibsam his son, and Mishma his son. ²⁶The sons of Mishma: Hammuel his son, Zaccur his son, Shimei his son. ²⁷Shimei had sixteen sons and six daughters; but his brothers didn't have many children, and all their family didn't multiply like the children of Judah. ²⁸They lived at Beersheba, Moladah, Hazarshual, ²⁹at Bilhah, at Ezem, at Tolad, ³⁰at Bethuel, at Hormah, at Ziklag, ³¹at Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susim, at Beth Biri, and at Shaaraim. These were their cities until David's reign. ³²Their villages were Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Tochen, and Ashan, five cities; ³³and all their villages that were around the same cities, as far as Baal. These were their settlements, and they kept their genealogy. ³⁴Meshobab, Jamlech, Joshah the son of Amaziah, ³⁵Joel, Jehu the son of Joshibiah, the son of Seraiah, the son of Asiel, ³⁶Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohai, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, Benaiah, ³⁷and Ziza the son of Shiphi, the son of Allon, the son of Jedaiah, the son of Shimri, the son of Shemaiah— ³⁸these mentioned by name were princes in their families. Their fathers' houses increased greatly. ³⁹They went to the entrance of Gedor, even to the east side of the valley, to seek pasture for their flocks. ⁴⁰They found rich, good pasture, and the land was wide, and quiet, and peaceful, for those who lived there before were descended from Ham. ⁴¹These written by name came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and struck their tents and the Meunim who were found there; and they destroyed them utterly to this day, and lived in their place, because there was pasture there for their flocks. ⁴²Some of them, even of the sons of Simeon, five hundred men, went to Mount Seir, having for their captains Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi. ⁴³They struck the remnant of the Amalekites who escaped, and have lived there to this day.

⁵The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel (for he was the firstborn, but because he defiled his father's couch, his birthright was given to the sons of Joseph the son of Israel; and the genealogy is not to be listed according to the birthright. ²For Judah prevailed above his brothers, and from him came the prince; but the birthright was Joseph's)— ³the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi. ⁴The sons of Joel: Shemaiah his son, Gog his son, Shimei his son, ⁵Micah his son, Reaiah his son, Baal his son, ⁶and Beerah his son, whom Tilgath Pilneser king of Assyria carried away captive. He was prince of the Reubenites. ⁷His brothers by their families, when the genealogy of their generations was listed: the chief, Jeiel, and Zechariah, ⁸and Bela the son of Azaz, the son of Shema, the son of Joel, who lived in Aroer, even to Nebo and Baal Meon; ⁹and he lived

ⁱⁱ"Jabez" sounds similar to the Hebrew word for "pain".

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

^{iv}Greek and Vulgate add "and Meonothai"

eastward even to the entrance of the wilderness from the river Euphrates, because their livestock were multiplied in the land of Gilead. ¹⁰In the days of Saul, they made war with the Hagrites, who fell by their hand; and they lived in their tents throughout all the land east of Gilead. ¹¹The sons of Gad lived beside them in the land of Bashan to Salecah: ¹²Joel the chief, Shapham the second, Janai, and Shaphat in Bashan. ¹³Their brothers of their fathers' houses: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber, seven. ¹⁴These were the sons of Abihail, the son of Huri, the son of Jaroah, the son of Gilead, the son of Michael, the son of Jeshishai, the son of Jahdo, the son of Buz; ¹⁵Ahi the son of Abdiel, the son of Guni, chief of their fathers' houses. ¹⁶They lived in Gilead in Bashan and in its towns, and in all the pasture lands of Sharon as far as their borders. ¹⁷All these were listed by genealogies in the days of Jotham king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam king of Israel. ¹⁸The sons of Reuben, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, of valiant men, men able to bear buckler and sword, able to shoot with bow, and skillful in war, were forty-four thousand seven hundred sixty that were able to go out to war. ¹⁹They made war with the Hagrites, with Jetur, and Naphish, and Nodab. ²⁰They were helped against them, and the Hagrites were delivered into their hand, and all who were with them; for they cried to God in the battle, and he answered them because they put their trust in him. ²¹They took away their livestock: of their camels fifty thousand, and of sheep two hundred fifty thousand, and of donkeys two thousand, and of men one hundred thousand. ²²For many fell slain, because the war was of God. They lived in their place until the captivity. ²³The children of the half-tribe of Manasseh lived in the land. They increased from Bashan to Baal Hermon, Senir, and Mount Hermon. ²⁴These were the heads of their fathers' houses: Ephraim, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel—mighty men of valor, famous men, heads of their fathers' houses. ²⁵They trespassed against the God of their fathers, and played the prostitute after the gods of the peoples of the land whom God destroyed before them. ²⁶So the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria, and the spirit of Tilgath Pilneser king of Assyria, and he carried away the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, and brought them to Halah, Habor, Hara, and to the river of Gozan, to this day.

⁶The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. ²The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. ³The children of Amram: Aaron, Moses, and Miriam. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. ⁴Eleazar became the father of Phinehas, Phinehas became the father of Abishua, ⁵Abishua became the father of Bukki. Bukki became the father of Uzzi. ⁶Uzzi became the father of Zerahiah. Zerahiah became the father of Meraioth.

⁷Meraioth became the father of Amariah. Amariah became the father of Ahitub. ⁸Ahitub became the father of Zadok. Zadok became the father of Ahimaaz. ⁹Ahimaaz became the father of Azariah. Azariah became the father of Yochanan. ¹⁰Yochanan became the father of Azariah, who executed the priest's office in the house that Solomon built in Jerusalem. ¹¹Azariah became the father of Amariah. Amariah became the father of Ahitub. ¹²Ahitub became the father of Zadok. Zadok became the father of Shallum. ¹³Shallum became the father of Hilkiah. Hilkiah became the father of Azariah. ¹⁴Azariah became the father of Seraiah. Seraiah became the father of Jehozadak. ¹⁵Jehozadak went into captivity when the LORD carried Judah and Jerusalem away by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar. ¹⁶The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. ¹⁷These are the names of the sons of Gershon: Libni and Shimei. ¹⁸The sons of Kohath were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. ¹⁹The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to their fathers' households. ²⁰Of Gershon: Libni his son, Jahath his son, Zimmah his son, ²¹Joah his son, Iddo his son, Zerah his son, and Jeatherai his son. ²²The sons of Kohath: Aminadab his son, Korah his son, Assir his son, ²³Elkanah his son, Ebiasaph his son, Assir his son, ²⁴Tahath his son, Uriel his son, Uziah his son, and Shaul his son. ²⁵The sons of Elkanah: Amasai and Ahimoth. ²⁶As for Elkanah, the sons of Elkanah: Zophai his son, Nahath his son, ²⁷Eliab his son, Jeroham his son, and Elkanah his son. ²⁸The sons of Samuel: the firstborn, Joel, and the second, Abijah. ²⁹The sons of Merari: Mahli, Libni his son, Shimei his son, Uziah his son, ³⁰Shimea his son, Haggiah his son, Asaiah his son. ³¹These are they whom David set over the service of song in the LORD's house after the ark came to rest there. ³²They ministered with song before the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting until Solomon had built the LORD's house in Jerusalem. They performed the duties of their office according to their order. ³³These are those who served, and their sons. Of the sons of the Kohathites: Heman the singer, the son of Joel, the son of Samuel, ³⁴the son of Elkanah, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliel, the son of Toah, ³⁵the son of Zuph, the son of Elkanah, the son of Mahath, the son of Amasai, ³⁶the son of Elkanah, the son of Joel, the son of Azariah, the son of Zephaniah, ³⁷the son of Tahath, the son of Assir, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, ³⁸the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, the son of Israel. ³⁹His brother Asaph, who stood on his right hand, even Asaph the son of Berechiah, the son of Shimea, ⁴⁰the son of Michael, the son of Baaseiah, the son of Malchijah, ⁴¹the son of Ethni, the son of Zerah, the son of Adaiah, ⁴²the son of Ethan, the son of Zimmah, the son of Shimei, ⁴³the son of Jahath, the son of Gershon, the son of Levi. ⁴⁴On the left hand their brothers the sons of Merari: Ethan the son of Kishi, the son of Abdi, the son of Malluch, ⁴⁵the son of Hashabiah,

the son of Amaziah, the son of Hilkiah, ⁴⁶the son of Amzi, the son of Bani, the son of Shemer, ⁴⁷the son of Mahli, the son of Mushi, the son of Merari, the son of Levi. ⁴⁸Their brothers the Levites were appointed for all the service of the tabernacle of God's house. ⁴⁹But Aaron and his sons offered on the altar of burnt offering, and on the altar of incense, for all the work of the most holy place, and to make atonement for Israel, according to all that Moses the servant of God had commanded. ⁵⁰These are the sons of Aaron: Eleazar his son, Phinehas his son, Abishua his son, ⁵¹Bukki his son, Uzzi his son, Zerahiah his son, ⁵²Meraioth his son, Amariah his son, Ahitub his son, ⁵³Zadok his son, and Ahimaaz his son. ⁵⁴Now these are their dwelling places according to their encampments in their borders: to the sons of Aaron, of the families of the Kohathites (for theirs was the first lot), ⁵⁵to them they gave Hebron in the land of Judah, and its pasture lands around it; ⁵⁶but the fields of the city and its villages, they gave to Caleb the son of Jephunneh. ⁵⁷To the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of refuge, Hebron, Libnah also with its pasture lands, Jattir, Eshtemoa with its pasture lands, ⁵⁸Hilen with its pasture lands, Debir with its pasture lands, ⁵⁹Ashan with its pasture lands, and Beth Shemesh with its pasture lands; ⁶⁰and out of the tribe of Benjamin, Geba with its pasture lands, Allemeth with its pasture lands, and Anathoth with its pasture lands. All their cities throughout their families were thirteen cities. ⁶¹To the rest of the sons of Kohath were given by lot, out of the family of the tribe, out of the half-tribe, the half of Manasseh, ten cities. ⁶²To the sons of Gershom, according to their families, out of the tribe of Issachar, and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the tribe of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities. ⁶³To the sons of Merari were given by lot, according to their families, out of the tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities. ⁶⁴The children of Israel gave to the Levites the cities with their pasture lands. ⁶⁵They gave by lot out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, and out of the tribe of the children of Benjamin, these cities which are mentioned by name. ⁶⁶Some of the families of the sons of Kohath had cities of their borders out of the tribe of Ephraim. ⁶⁷They gave to them the cities of refuge, Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim with its pasture lands and Gezer with its pasture lands, ⁶⁸Jokmeam with its pasture lands, Beth Horon with its pasture lands, ⁶⁹Aijalon with its pasture lands, Gath Rimmon with its pasture lands; ⁷⁰and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh, Aner with its pasture lands, and Bileam with its pasture lands, for the rest of the family of the sons of Kohath. ⁷¹To the sons of Gershom were given, out of the family of the half-tribe of Manasseh, Golan in Bashan with its pasture lands, and Ashtaroth with its pasture lands; ⁷²and out of the tribe of Issachar, Kedesh with its pasture lands, Daberath with its pasture lands, ⁷³Ramoth with

its pasture lands, and Anem with its pasture lands; ⁷⁴and out of the tribe of Asher, Mashal with its pasture lands, Abdon with its pasture lands, ⁷⁵Hukok with its pasture lands, and Rehob with its pasture lands; ⁷⁶and out of the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee with its pasture lands, Hammon with its pasture lands, and Kiriathaim with its pasture lands. ⁷⁷To the rest of the Levites, the sons of Merari, were given, out of the tribe of Zebulun, Rimmono with its pasture lands, and Tabor with its pasture lands; ⁷⁸and beyond the Jordan at Jericho, on the east side of the Jordan, were given them out of the tribe of Reuben: Bezer in the wilderness with its pasture lands, Jahzah with its pasture lands, ⁷⁹Kedemoth with its pasture lands, and Mephaath with its pasture lands; ⁸⁰and out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead with its pasture lands, Mahanaim with its pasture lands, ⁸¹Heshbon with its pasture lands, and Jazer with its pasture lands.

7Of the sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah, Jashub, and Shimron, four. ²The sons of Tola: Uzzi, Rephaiah, Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Shemuel, heads of their fathers' houses, of Tola; mighty men of valor in their generations. Their number in the days of David was twenty-two thousand six hundred. ³The son of Uzzi: Izrahiah. The sons of Izrahiah: Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and Isshiah, five; all of them chief men. ⁴With them, by their generations, after their fathers' houses, were bands of the army for war, thirty-six thousand; for they had many wives and sons. ⁵Their brothers among all the families of Issachar, mighty men of valor, listed in all by genealogy, were eighty-seven thousand. ⁶The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher, and Jediael, three. ⁷The sons of Bela: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel, Jerimoth, and Iri, five; heads of fathers' houses, mighty men of valor; and they were listed by genealogy twenty-two thousand thirty-four. ⁸The sons of Becher: Zemirah, Joash, Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah, Anathoth, and Alemeth. All these were the sons of Becher. ⁹They were listed by genealogy, after their generations, heads of their fathers' houses, mighty men of valor, twenty thousand two hundred. ¹⁰The son of Jediael: Bilhan. The sons of Bilhan: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud, Chenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, and Ahishahar. ¹¹All these were sons of Jediael, according to the heads of their fathers' households, mighty men of valor, seventeen thousand two hundred, who were able to go out in the army for war. ¹²So were Shuphim, Huphim, the sons of Ir, Hushim, and the sons of Aher. ¹³The sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer, Shallum, and the sons of Bilhah. ¹⁴The sons of Manasseh: Asriel, whom his concubine the Aramitess bore. She bore Machir the father of Gilead. ¹⁵Machir took a wife of Huphim and Shuphim, whose sister's name was Maacah. The name of the second was Zelophehad; and Zelophehad had daughters. ¹⁶Maacah the wife of Machir bore a son, and she named him Peresh. The name of

his brother was Sheresh; and his sons were Ulam and Rakem. ¹⁷The sons of Ulam: Bedan. These were the sons of Gilead the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh. ¹⁸His sister Hammolecheth bore Ishhod, Abiezer, and Mahlah. ¹⁹The sons of Shemida were Ahian, Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam. ²⁰The sons of Ephraim: Shuthelah, Bered his son, Tahath his son, Eleadah his son, Tahath his son, ²¹Zabad his son, Shuthelah his son, Ezer, and Elead, whom the men of Gath who were born in the land killed, because they came down to take away their livestock. ²²Ephraim their father mourned many days, and his brothers came to comfort him. ²³He went in to his wife, and she conceived and bore a son, and he named him Beriah, ^v because there was trouble with his house. ²⁴His daughter was Sheerah, who built Beth Horon the lower and the upper, and Uzzan Sheerah. ²⁵Rephah was his son, Resheph his son, Telah his son, Tahan his son, ²⁶Ladan his son, Ammihud his son, Elishama his son, ²⁷Nun his son, and Joshua his son. ²⁸Their possessions and settlements were Bethel and its towns, and eastward Naaran, and westward Gezer with its towns; Shechem also and its towns, to Azzah and its towns; ²⁹and by the borders of the children of Manasseh, Beth Shean and its towns, Taanach and its towns, Megiddo and its towns, and Dor and its towns. The children of Joseph the son of Israel lived in these. ³⁰The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah, Ishvi, and Beriah. Serah was their sister. ³¹The sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel, who was the father of Birzaith. ³²Heber became the father of Japhlet, Shomer, Hotham, and Shua their sister. ³³The sons of Japhlet: Pasach, Bimhal, and Ashvath. These are the children of Japhlet. ³⁴The sons of Shemer: Ahi, Rohgah, Jehubbah, and Aram. ³⁵The sons of Helem his brother: Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, and Amal. ³⁶The sons of Zophah: Suah, Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah, ³⁷Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah, Ithran, and Beera. ³⁸The sons of Jether: Jephunneh, Pispah, and Ara. ³⁹The sons of Ulla: Arah, Hanniel, and Rizia. ⁴⁰All these were the children of Asher, heads of the fathers' houses, choice and mighty men of valor, chief of the princes. The number of them listed by genealogy for service in war was twenty-six thousand men.

⁸Benjamin became the father of Bela his firstborn, Ashbel the second, Aharah the third, ²Nohah the fourth, and Rapha the fifth. ³Bela had sons: Addar, Gera, Abihud, ⁴Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah, ⁵Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram. ⁶These are the sons of Ehud. These are the heads of fathers' households of the inhabitants of Geba, who were carried captive to Manahath: ⁷Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera, who carried them captive; and he became the father of Uzza and Ahihud. ⁸Shaharaim became the father of children in the field of Moab, after he had sent them away. Hushim and Baara were his wives. ⁹By Hodesh his wife,

he became the father of Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam, ¹⁰Jeuz, Shachia, and Mirmah. These were his sons, heads of fathers' households. ¹¹By Hushim, he became the father of Abitub and Elpaal. ¹²The sons of Elpaal: Eber, Misham, and Shemed, who built Ono and Lod, with its towns; ¹³and Beriah and Shema, who were heads of fathers' households of the inhabitants of Aijalon, who put to flight the inhabitants of Gath; ¹⁴and Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth, ¹⁵Zebadiah, Arad, Eder, ¹⁶Michael, Ishpah, Joha, the sons of Beriah, ¹⁷Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber, ¹⁸Ishmerai, Izliah, Jobab, the sons of Elpaal, ¹⁹Jakim, Zichri, Zabdi, ²⁰Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel, ²¹Adaiah, Beraiah, Shimrath, the sons of Shimei, ²²Ishpan, Eber, Eliel, ²³Abdon, Zichri, Hanan, ²⁴Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah, ²⁵Iphdeiah, Penuel, the sons of Shashak, ²⁶Shamsherai, Shehariah, Athaliah, ²⁷Jaareshiah, Elijah, Zichri, and the sons of Jeroham. ²⁸These were heads of fathers' households throughout their generations, chief men. These lived in Jerusalem. ²⁹The father of Gibeon, whose wife's name was Maacah, lived in Gibeon ³⁰with his firstborn son Abdon, Zur, Kish, Baal, Nadab, ³¹Gedor, Ahio, Zecher, ³²and Mikloth, who became the father of Shimeah. They also lived with their families in Jerusalem, near their relatives. ³³Ner became the father of Kish. Kish became the father of Saul. Saul became the father of Jonathan, Malchishua, Abinadab, and Eshbaal. ³⁴The son of Jonathan was Meribbaal. Meribbaal became the father of Micah. ³⁵The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech, Tarea, and Ahaz. ³⁶Ahaz became the father of Jehoaddah. Jehoaddah became the father of Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri became the father of Moza. ³⁷Moza became the father of Binea. Raphah was his son, Eleasah his son, and Azel his son. ³⁸Azel had six sons, whose names are these: Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. All these were the sons of Azel. ³⁹The sons of Eshek his brother: Ulam his firstborn, Jeush the second, and Eliphelet the third. ⁴⁰The sons of Ulam were mighty men of valor, archers, and had many sons, and grandsons, one hundred fifty. All these were of the sons of Benjamin.

⁹So all Israel were listed by genealogies; and behold, ^{vi} they are written in the book of the kings of Israel. Judah was carried away captive to Babylon for their disobedience. ²Now the first inhabitants who lived in their possessions in their cities were Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the temple servants. ³In Jerusalem, there lived of the children of Judah, of the children of Benjamin, and of the children of Ephraim and Manasseh: ⁴Uthai the son of Ammihud, the son of Omri, the son of Imri, the son of Bani, of the children of Perez the son of Judah. ⁵Of the Shilonites: Asaiah the firstborn and his sons. ⁶Of the sons of Zerah: Jeuel and their brothers, six hundred ninety. ⁷Of the sons

^v"Beriah" is similar to the Hebrew word for "misfortune".

^{vi}"Behold", from , " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

of Benjamin: Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Hodaviah, the son of Hassenuah; ⁸and Ibneiah the son of Jeroham, and Elah the son of Uzzi, the son of Michri; and Meshullam the son of Shephatiah, the son of Reuel, the son of Ibnijah; ⁹and their brothers, according to their generations, nine hundred fifty-six. All these men were heads of fathers' households by their fathers' houses. ¹⁰Of the priests: Jedaiah, Jehoiarib, Jachin, ¹¹and Azariah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the ruler of God's house; ¹²and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malchijah; and Maasai the son of Adiel, the son of Jahzerah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Meshillemith, the son of Immer; ¹³and their brothers, heads of their fathers' houses, one thousand seven hundred sixty; they were very able men for the work of the service of God's house. ¹⁴Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, of the sons of Merari; ¹⁵and Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, and Mattaniah the son of Mica, the son of Zichri, the son of Asaph, ¹⁶and Obadiah the son of Shemaiah, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun; and Berechiah the son of Asa, the son of Elkannah, who lived in the villages of the Netophathites. ¹⁷The gatekeepers: Shallum, Akkub, Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers (Shallum was the chief), ¹⁸who previously served in the king's gate eastward. They were the gatekeepers for the camp of the children of Levi. ¹⁹Shallum was the son of Kore, the son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and his brothers, of his father's house, the Korahites, were over the work of the service, keepers of the thresholds of the tent. Their fathers had been over the LORD's camp, keepers of the entry. ²⁰Phinehas the son of Eleazar was ruler over them in time past, and the LORD was with him. ²¹Zechariah the son of Meshelemiah was gatekeeper of the door of the Tent of Meeting. ²²All these who were chosen to be gatekeepers in the thresholds were two hundred twelve. These were listed by genealogy in their villages, whom David and Samuel the seer ordained in their office of trust. ²³So they and their children had the oversight of the gates of the LORD's house, even the house of the tent, as guards. ²⁴On the four sides were the gatekeepers, toward the east, west, north, and south. ²⁵Their brothers, in their villages, were to come in every seven days from time to time to be with them, ²⁶for the four chief gatekeepers, who were Levites, were in an office of trust, and were over the rooms and over the treasuries in God's house. ²⁷They stayed around God's house, because that was their duty; and it was their duty to open it morning by morning. ²⁸Certain of them were in charge of the vessels of service, for these were brought in by count, and these were taken out by count. ²⁹Some of them also were appointed over the furniture, and over all the vessels of the sanctuary, over the fine flour, the wine, the oil, the frankincense, and the spices. ³⁰Some of the sons of the priests prepared the mixing of the spices.

³¹Mattithiah, one of the Levites, who was the firstborn of Shallum the Korahite, had the office of trust over the things that were baked in pans. ³²Some of their brothers, of the sons of the Kohathites, were over the show bread, to prepare it every Sabbath. ³³These are the singers, heads of fathers' households of the Levites, who lived in the rooms and were free from other service, for they were employed in their work day and night. ³⁴These were heads of fathers' households of the Levites, throughout their generations, chief men. They lived at Jerusalem. ³⁵Jeiel the father of Gibeon, whose wife's name was Maacah, lived in Gibeon. ³⁶His firstborn son was Abdon, then Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab, ³⁷Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth. ³⁸Mikloth became the father of Shimeam. They also lived with their relatives in Jerusalem, near their relatives. ³⁹Ner became the father of Kish. Kish became the father of Saul. Saul became the father of Jonathan, Malchishua, Abinadab, and Eshbaal. ⁴⁰The son of Jonathan was Meribbaal. Meribbaal became the father of Micah. ⁴¹The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz. ⁴²Ahaz became the father of Jarah. Jarah became the father of Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri became the father of Moza. ⁴³Moza became the father of Binea, Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, and Azel his son. ⁴⁴Azel had six sons, whose names are Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. These were the sons of Azel.

¹⁰Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain on Mount Gilboa. ²The Philistines followed hard after Saul and after his sons; and the Philistines killed Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malchishua, the sons of Saul. ³The battle went hard against Saul, and the archers overtook him; and he was distressed by reason of the archers. ⁴Then Saul said to his armor bearer, "Draw your sword, and thrust me through with it, lest these uncircumcised come and abuse me." But his armor bearer would not, for he was terrified. Therefore Saul took his sword and fell on it. ⁵When his armor bearer saw that Saul was dead, he likewise fell on his sword and died. ⁶So Saul died with his three sons; and all his house died together. ⁷When all the men of Israel who were in the valley saw that they fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, they abandoned their cities, and fled; and the Philistines came and lived in them. ⁸On the next day, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, they found Saul and his sons fallen on Mount Gilboa. ⁹They stripped him and took his head and his armor, then sent into the land of the Philistines all around to carry the news to their idols and to the people. ¹⁰They put his armor in the house of their gods, and fastened his head in the house of Dagon. ¹¹When all Jabesh Gilead heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul, ¹²all the valiant men arose and took away the body of Saul and

the bodies of his sons, and brought them to Jabesh, and buried their bones under the oak in Jabesh, and fasted seven days. ¹³So Saul died for his trespass which he committed against the LORD, because of the LORD's word, which he didn't keep, and also because he asked counsel of one who had a familiar spirit, to inquire, ¹⁴and didn't inquire of the LORD. Therefore he killed him, and turned the kingdom over to David the son of Jesse.

11Then all Israel gathered themselves to David to Hebron, saying, "Behold, we are your bone and your flesh. ²In times past, even when Saul was king, it was you who led out and brought in Israel. The LORD your God said to you, 'You shall be shepherd of my people Israel, and you shall be prince over my people Israel.'" ³So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and David made a covenant with them in Hebron before the LORD. They anointed David king over Israel, according to the LORD's word by Samuel. ⁴David and all Israel went to Jerusalem (also called Jebus); and the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land, were there. ⁵The inhabitants of Jebus said to David, "You will not come in here!" Nevertheless David took the stronghold of Zion. The same is David's city. ⁶David had said, "Whoever strikes the Jebusites first shall be chief and captain." Joab the son of Zeruiah went up first, and was made chief. ⁷David lived in the stronghold; therefore they called it David's city. ⁸He built the city all around, from Millo even around; and Joab repaired the rest of the city. ⁹David grew greater and greater, for the LORD of Hosts was with him. ¹⁰Now these are the chief of the mighty men whom David had, who showed themselves strong with him in his kingdom, together with all Israel, to make him king, according to the LORD's word concerning Israel. ¹¹This is the number of the mighty men whom David had: Jashobeam, the son of a Hachmonite, the chief of the thirty; he lifted up his spear against three hundred and killed them at one time. ¹²After him was Eleazar the son of Dodo, the Ahohite, who was one of the three mighty men. ¹³He was with David at Pasdammim, and there the Philistines were gathered together to battle, where there was a plot of ground full of barley; and the people fled from before the Philistines. ¹⁴They stood in the middle of the plot, defended it, and killed the Philistines; and the LORD saved them by a great victory. ¹⁵Three of the thirty chief men went down to the rock to David, into the cave of Adullam; and the army of the Philistines were encamped in the valley of Rephaim. ¹⁶David was then in the stronghold, and the garrison of the Philistines was in Bethlehem at that time. ¹⁷David longed, and said, "Oh, that someone would give me water to drink from the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate!" ¹⁸The three broke through the army of the Philistines, and drew water out of the well of Bethlehem that was by the gate, took it, and brought it to David; but David would not drink any of

it, but poured it out to the LORD, ¹⁹and said, "My God forbid me, that I should do this! Shall I drink the blood of these men who have put their lives in jeopardy?" For they risked their lives to bring it. Therefore he would not drink it. The three mighty men did these things. ²⁰Abishai, the brother of Joab, was chief of the three; for he lifted up his spear against three hundred and killed them, and had a name among the three. ²¹Of the three, he was more honorable than the two, and was made their captain; however he wasn't included in the three. ²²Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done mighty deeds, killed the two sons of Ariel of Moab. He also went down and killed a lion in the middle of a pit on a snowy day. ²³He killed an Egyptian, a man of great stature, five cubits ^{vii} high. In the Egyptian's hand was a spear like a weaver's beam; and he went down to him with a staff, plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and killed him with his own spear. ²⁴Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did these things and had a name among the three mighty men. ²⁵Behold, he was more honorable than the thirty, but he didn't attain to the three; and David set him over his guard. ²⁶The mighty men of the armies also include Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem, ²⁷Shammoth the Hararite, Helez the Pelonite, ²⁸Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite, Abiezer the Anathothite, ²⁹Sibbecai the Hushathite, Ilai the Ahohite, ³⁰Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the son of Baanah the Netophathite, ³¹Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah of the children of Benjamin, Benaiah the Pirathonite, ³²Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel the Arbathite, ³³Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba the Shaalbonite, ³⁴the sons of Hashem the Gizonite, Jonathan the son of Shagee the Hararite, ³⁵Ahiam the son of Sacar the Hararite, Eliphaz the son of Ur, ³⁶Hepher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the Pelonite, ³⁷Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son of Ezbai, ³⁸Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar the son of Hagri, ³⁹Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Berothite (the armor bearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah), ⁴⁰Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite, ⁴¹Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of Ahlai, ⁴²Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite (a chief of the Reubenites), and thirty with him, ⁴³Hanan the son of Maacah, Joshaphat the Mithnite, ⁴⁴Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and Jeiel the sons of Hotham the Aroerite, ⁴⁵Jediael the son of Shimri, and Joha his brother, the Tizite, ⁴⁶Eliel the Mahavite, and Jeribai, and Joshaviah, the sons of Elnaam, and Ithmah the Moabite, ⁴⁷Eliel, Obed, and Jaasiel the Mezobaite.

12Now these are those who came to David to Ziklag while he was a fugitive from Saul the son of Kish. They were among the mighty men, his helpers in war. ²They

^{vii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. Therefore this Egyptian was about 7 feet and 6 inches or 2.28 meters tall.

were armed with bows, and could use both the right hand and the left in slinging stones and in shooting arrows from the bow. They were of Saul's relatives of the tribe of Benjamin. ³The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, the sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; Jeziel and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth; Beracah; Jehu the Anathothite; ⁴Ishmaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man among the thirty and a leader of the thirty; Jeremiah; Jahaziel; Yochanan; Jozabad the Gederathite; ⁵Eluzai; Jerimoth; Bealiah; Shemariah; Shephatiah the Haruphite; ⁶Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and Jashobeam, the Korahites; ⁷and Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of Jeroham of Gedor. ⁸Some Gadites joined David in the stronghold in the wilderness, mighty men of valor, men trained for war, who could handle shield and spear; whose faces were like the faces of lions, and they were as swift as the gazelles on the mountains: ⁹Ezer the chief, Obadiah the second, Eliab the third, ¹⁰Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the fifth, ¹¹Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh, ¹²Yochanan the eighth, Elzabad the ninth, ¹³Jeremiah the tenth, and Machbannai the eleventh. ¹⁴These of the sons of Gad were captains of the army. He who was least was equal to one hundred, and the greatest to one thousand. ¹⁵These are those who went over the Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed all its banks; and they put to flight all who lived in the valleys, both toward the east and toward the west. ¹⁶Some of the children of Benjamin and Judah came to the stronghold to David. ¹⁷David went out to meet them, and answered them, "If you have come peaceably to me to help me, my heart will be united with you; but if you have come to betray me to my adversaries, since there is no wrong in my hands, may the God of our fathers see this and rebuke it." ¹⁸Then the Spirit came on Amasai, who was chief of the thirty, and he said, "We are yours, David, and on your side, you son of Jesse. Peace, peace be to you, and peace be to your helpers; for your God helps you." Then David received them and made them captains of the band. ¹⁹Some of Manasseh also joined David when he came with the Philistines against Saul to battle, but they didn't help them, for the lords of the Philistines sent him away after consultation, saying, "He will desert to his master Saul to the jeopardy of our heads." ²⁰As he went to Ziklag, some from Manasseh joined him: Adnah, Jozabad, Jediael, Michael, Jozabad, Elihu, and Zillethai, captains of thousands who were of Manasseh. ²¹They helped David against the band of raiders, for they were all mighty men of valor and were captains in the army. ²²For from day to day men came to David to help him, until there was a great army, like God's army. ²³These are the numbers of the heads of those who were armed for war, who came to David to Hebron to turn the kingdom of Saul to him, according to the LORD's word. ²⁴The children of Judah who bore shield and spear were six thousand eight hundred, armed for war. ²⁵Of the children of Simeon, mighty men of

valor for the war: seven thousand one hundred. ²⁶Of the children of Levi: four thousand six hundred. ²⁷Jehoiada was the leader of the household of Aaron; and with him were three thousand seven hundred, ²⁸and Zadok, a young man mighty of valor, and of his father's house twenty-two captains. ²⁹Of the children of Benjamin, Saul's relatives: three thousand, for until then, the greatest part of them had kept their allegiance to Saul's house. ³⁰Of the children of Ephraim: twenty thousand eight hundred, mighty men of valor, famous men in their fathers' houses. ³¹Of the half-tribe of Manasseh: eighteen thousand, who were mentioned by name, to come and make David king. ³²Of the children of Issachar, men who had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do, their heads were two hundred; and all their brothers were at their command. ³³Of Zebulun, such as were able to go out in the army, who could set the battle in array with all kinds of instruments of war: fifty thousand who could command and were not of double heart. ³⁴Of Naphtali: one thousand captains, and with them with shield and spear thirty-seven thousand. ³⁵Of the Danites who could set the battle in array: twenty-eight thousand six hundred. ³⁶Of Asher, such as were able to go out in the army, who could set the battle in array: forty thousand. ³⁷On the other side of the Jordan, of the Reubenites, the Gadites, and of the half-tribe of Manasseh, with all kinds of instruments of war for the battle: one hundred twenty thousand. ³⁸All these were men of war who could order the battle array, and came with a perfect heart to Hebron to make David king over all Israel; and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king. ³⁹They were there with David three days, eating and drinking; for their brothers had supplied provisions for them. ⁴⁰Moreover those who were near to them, as far as Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali, brought bread on donkeys, on camels, on mules, and on oxen: supplies of flour, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine, oil, cattle, and sheep in abundance; for there was joy in Israel.

13David consulted with the captains of thousands and of hundreds, even with every leader. ²David said to all the assembly of Israel, "If it seems good to you, and if it is of the LORD our God, let's send word everywhere to our brothers who are left in all Eretz-Israel, with whom the priests and Levites are in their cities that have pasture lands, that they may gather themselves to us. ³Also, let's bring the ark of our God back to us again, for we didn't seek it in the days of Saul." ⁴All the assembly said that they would do so, for the thing was right in the eyes of all the people. ⁵So David assembled all Israel together, from the Shihor River of Egypt even to the entrance of Hamath, to bring God's ark from Kiriath Jearim. ⁶David went up with all Israel to Baalah, that is, to Kiriath Jearim, which belonged to Judah, to bring up from there God the LORD's ark that sits above the cherubim, that is called

by the Name. ⁷They carried God's ark on a new cart, and brought it out of Abinadab's house; and Uzza and Ahio drove the cart. ⁸David and all Israel played before God with all their might, even with songs, with harps, with stringed instruments, with tambourines, with cymbals, and with shofars ^{viii} . . . or, trumpets ⁹When they came to Chidon's threshing floor, Uzza put out his hand to hold the ark, for the oxen stumbled. ¹⁰The LORD's anger burned against Uzza, and he struck him because he put his hand on the ark; and he died there before God. ¹¹David was displeased, because the LORD had broken out against Uzza. He called that place Perez Uzza, to this day. ¹²David was afraid of God that day, saying, "How can I bring God's ark home to me?" ¹³So David didn't move the ark with him into David's city, but carried it aside into Obed-Edom the Gittite's house. ¹⁴God's ark remained with the family of Obed-Edom in his house three months; and the LORD blessed Obed-Edom's house and all that he had.

¹⁴Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David with cedar trees, masons, and carpenters, to build him a house. ²David perceived that the LORD had established him king over Israel, for his kingdom was highly exalted, for his people Israel's sake. ³David took more wives in Jerusalem, and David became the father of more sons and daughters. ⁴These are the names of the children whom he had in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon, ⁵Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet, ⁶Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia, ⁷Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet. ⁸When the Philistines heard that David was anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to seek David; and David heard of it, and went out against them. ⁹Now the Philistines had come and made a raid in the valley of Rephaim. ¹⁰David inquired of God, saying, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will you deliver them into my hand?" The LORD said to him, "Go up; for I will deliver them into your hand." ¹¹So they came up to Baal Perazim, and David defeated them there. David said, God has broken my enemies by my hand, like waters breaking out. Therefore they called the name of that place Baal Perazim. ^{ix} ¹²They left their gods there; and David gave a command, and they were burned with fire. ¹³The Philistines made a another raid in the valley. ¹⁴David inquired again of God; and God said to him, "You shall not go up after them. Turn away from them, and come on them opposite the mulberry trees. ¹⁵When you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then go out to battle; for God has gone out before you to strike the army of the Philistines." ¹⁶David did as God commanded him; and they attacked the army of the Philistines from Gibeon even to Gezer. ¹⁷The fame of

David went out into all lands; and the LORD brought the fear of him on all nations.

¹⁵David made himself houses in David's city; and he prepared a place for God's ark, and pitched a tent for it. ²Then David said, "No one ought to carry God's ark but the Levites. For the LORD has chosen them to carry God's ark, and to minister to him forever." ³David assembled all Israel at Jerusalem, to bring up the LORD's ark to its place, which he had prepared for it. ⁴David gathered together the sons of Aaron and the Levites: ⁵of the sons of Kohath, Uriel the chief, and his brothers one hundred twenty; ⁶of the sons of Merari, Asaiah the chief, and his brothers two hundred twenty; ⁷of the sons of Gershon, Joel the chief, and his brothers one hundred thirty; ⁸of the sons of Elizaphan, Shemaiah the chief, and his brothers two hundred; ⁹of the sons of Hebron, Eliel the chief, and his brothers eighty; ¹⁰of the sons of Uzziel, Amminadab the chief, and his brothers one hundred twelve. ¹¹David called for Zadok and Abiathar the priests, and for the Levites: for Uriel, Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and Amminadab, ¹²and said to them, "You are the heads of the fathers' households of the Levites. Sanctify yourselves, both you and your brothers, that you may bring the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel, up to the place that I have prepared for it. ¹³For because you didn't carry it at first, the LORD our God broke out in anger against us, because we didn't seek him according to the ordinance." ¹⁴So the priests and the Levites sanctified themselves to bring up the ark of the LORD, the God of Israel. ¹⁵The children of the Levites bore God's ark on their shoulders with its poles, as Moses commanded according to the LORD's word. ¹⁶David spoke to the chief of the Levites to appoint their brothers as singers with instruments of music, stringed instruments, harps, and cymbals, sounding aloud and lifting up their voices with joy. ¹⁷So the Levites appointed Heman the son of Joel; and of his brothers, Asaph the son of Berechiah; and of the sons of Merari their brothers, Ethan the son of Kushaiah; ¹⁸and with them their brothers of the second rank: Zechariah, Ben, Jaaziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel, the doorkeepers. ¹⁹So the singers, Heman, Asaph, and Ethan, were given cymbals of bronze to sound aloud; ²⁰and Zechariah, Aziel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and Benaiah, with stringed instruments set to Alamothe; ²¹and Mattithiah, Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, Jeiel, and Azariah, with harps tuned to the eight-stringed lyre, to lead. ²²Chenaniah, chief of the Levites, was over the singing. He taught the singers, because he was skillful. ²³Berechiah and Elkanah were doorkeepers for the ark. ²⁴Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel, Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer, the priests, blew the sho-

^{viii}or, trumpets.

^{ix}"Baal Perazim" means "The Lord who breaks out."

fars^x or, trumpets before God's ark; and Obed-Edom and Jehiah were doorkeepers for the ark. ²⁵So David, the elders of Israel, and the captains over thousands went to bring the ark of the LORD's covenant up out of the house of Obed-Edom with joy. ²⁶When God helped the Levites who bore the ark of the LORD's covenant, they sacrificed seven bulls and seven rams. ²⁷David was clothed with a robe of fine linen, as were all the Levites who bore the ark, the singers, and Chenaniah the choir master with the singers; and David had an ephod of linen on him. ²⁸Thus all Israel brought the ark of the LORD's covenant up with shouting, with sound of the cornet, with shofars^{xi}, or, trumpets and with cymbals, sounding aloud with stringed instruments and harps. ²⁹As the ark of the LORD's covenant came to David's city, Michal the daughter of Saul looked out at the window, and saw king David dancing and playing; and she despised him in her heart.

16 They brought in God's ark, and set it in the middle of the tent that David had pitched for it; and they offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before God. ²When David had finished offering the burnt offering and the peace offerings, he blessed the people in the LORD's name. ³He gave to everyone of Israel, both man and woman, to everyone a loaf of bread, a portion of meat, and a cake of raisins. ⁴He appointed some of the Levites to minister before the LORD's ark, and to commemorate, to thank, and to praise the LORD, the God of Israel: ⁵Asaph the chief, and second to him Zechariah, then Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel, with stringed instruments and with harps; and Asaph with cymbals, sounding aloud; ⁶with Benaiah and Jahaziel the priests with shofars^{xii} or, trumpets continually, before the ark of the covenant of God. ⁷Then on that day David first ordained giving of thanks to the LORD by the hand of Asaph and his brothers. ⁸Oh give thanks to the LORD. Call on his name. Make what he has done known among the peoples. ⁹Sing to him. Sing praises to him. Tell of all his marvelous works. ¹⁰Glory in his holy name. Let the heart of those who seek the LORD rejoice. ¹¹Seek the LORD and his strength. Seek his face forever more. ¹²Remember his marvelous works that he has done, his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth, ¹³you offspring^{xiii} of Israel his servant, you children of Jacob, his chosen ones. ¹⁴He is the LORD our God. His judgments are in all the earth. ¹⁵Remember his covenant forever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations, ¹⁶the covenant which he made with Abraham, his oath to Isaac. ¹⁷He confirmed it to Jacob for a statute, and to Israel for an everlasting covenant, ¹⁸saying, "I will give you the land of Canaan,

The lot of your inheritance," ¹⁹when you were but a few men in number, yes, very few, and foreigners in it. ²⁰They went about from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another people. ²¹He allowed no man to do them wrong. Yes, he reproveth kings for their sakes, ²²"Don't touch my anointed ones! Do my prophets no harm!" ²³Sing to the LORD, all the earth! Display his salvation from day to day. ²⁴Declare his glory among the nations, and his marvelous works among all the peoples. ²⁵For great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised. He also is to be feared above all gods. ²⁶For all the gods of the peoples are idols, but the LORD made the heavens. ²⁷Honor and majesty are before him. Strength and gladness are in his place. ²⁸Ascribe to the LORD, you families of the peoples, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength! ²⁹Ascribe to the LORD the glory due to his name. Bring an offering, and come before him. Worship the LORD in holy array. ³⁰Tremble before him, all the earth. The world also is established that it can't be moved. ³¹Let the heavens be glad, and let the earth rejoice! Let them say among the nations, "The LORD reigns!" ³²Let the sea roar, and its fullness! Let the field exult, and all that is in it! ³³Then the trees of the forest will sing for joy before the LORD, for he comes to judge the earth. ³⁴Oh give thanks to the LORD, for he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever. ³⁵Say, "Save us, God of our salvation! Gather us together and deliver us from the nations, to give thanks to your holy name, to triumph in your praise." ³⁶Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting even to everlasting. All the people said, "Amen," and praised the LORD. ³⁷So he left Asaph and his brothers there before the ark of the LORD's covenant, to minister before the ark continually, as every day's work required; ³⁸and Obed-Edom with their sixty-eight relatives; Obed-Edom also the son of Jeduthun and Hosah to be doorkeepers; ³⁹and Zadok the priest and his brothers the priests, before the LORD's tabernacle in the high place that was at Gibeon, ⁴⁰to offer burnt offerings to the LORD on the altar of burnt offering continually morning and evening, even according to all that is written in the LORD's law, which he commanded to Israel; ⁴¹and with them Heman and Jeduthun and the rest who were chosen, who were mentioned by name, to give thanks to the LORD, because his loving kindness endures forever; ⁴²and with them Heman and Jeduthun with shofars^{xiv} or, trumpets and cymbals for those that should sound aloud, and with instruments for the songs of God, and the sons of Jeduthun to be at the gate. ⁴³All the people departed, each man to his house; and David returned to bless his house.

17 When David was living in his house, David said to Nathan the prophet, "Behold, I live in a cedar house, but the ark of the LORD's covenant is in a tent." ²Nathan said

^xor, trumpets

^{xi}or, trumpets,

^{xii}or, trumpets

^{xiii}or, seed

^{xiv}or, trumpets

to David, "Do all that is in your heart; for God is with you." ³That same night, the word of God came to Nathan, saying, ⁴"Go and tell David my servant, 'The LORD says, 'You shall not build me a house to dwell in; ⁵for I have not lived in a house since the day that I brought up Israel to this day, but have gone from tent to tent, and from one tent to another. ⁶In all places in which I have walked with all Israel, did I speak a word with any of the judges of Israel, whom I commanded to be shepherd of my people, saying, 'Why have you not built me a house of cedar?'" ⁷"Now therefore, you shall tell my servant David, 'The LORD of Hosts says, "I took you from the sheep pen, from following the sheep, to be prince over my people Israel. ⁸I have been with you wherever you have gone, and have cut off all your enemies from before you. I will make you a name like the name of the great ones who are in the earth. ⁹I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place, and be moved no more. The children of wickedness will not waste them any more, as at the first, ¹⁰and from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. I will subdue all your enemies. Moreover I tell you that the LORD will build you a house. ¹¹It will happen, when your days are fulfilled that you must go to be with your fathers, that I will set up your offspring after you, who will be of your sons; and I will establish his kingdom. ¹²He will build me a house, and I will establish his throne forever. ¹³I will be his father, and he will be my son. I will not take my loving kindness away from him, as I took it from him who was before you; ¹⁴but I will settle him in my house and in my kingdom forever. His throne will be established forever.'" ¹⁵According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so Nathan spoke to David. ¹⁶Then David the king went in and sat before the LORD; and he said, "Who am I, LORD God, and what is my house, that you have brought me this far? ¹⁷This was a small thing in your eyes, O God, but you have spoken of your servant's house for a great while to come, and have respected me according to the standard of a man of high degree, LORD God. ¹⁸What can David say yet more to you concerning the honor which is done to your servant? For you know your servant. ¹⁹LORD, for your servant's sake, and according to your own heart, you have done all this greatness, to make known all these great things. ²⁰LORD, there is no one like you, neither is there any God besides you, according to all that we have heard with our ears. ²¹What one nation in the earth is like your people Israel, whom God went to redeem to himself for a people, to make you a name by great and awesome things, in driving out nations from before your people whom you redeemed out of Egypt? ²²For you made your people Israel your own people forever; and you, LORD, became their God. ²³Now, LORD, let the word that you have spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house, be established forever, and do as you have spoken. ²⁴Let your

name be established and magnified forever, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts is the God of Israel, even a God to Israel. The house of David your servant is established before you.' ²⁵For you, my God, have revealed to your servant that you will build him a house. Therefore your servant has found courage to pray before you. ²⁶Now, LORD, you are God, and have promised this good thing to your servant. ²⁷Now it has pleased you to bless the house of your servant, that it may continue forever before you; for you, LORD, have blessed, and it is blessed forever."

¹⁸After this, David defeated the Philistines and subdued them, and took Gath and its towns out of the hand of the Philistines. ²He defeated Moab; and the Moabites became servants to David and brought tribute. ³David defeated Hadadezer king of Zobah, toward Hamath, as he went to establish his dominion by the river Euphrates. ⁴David took from him one thousand chariots, seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen; and David hamstringed all the chariot horses, but reserved of them enough for one hundred chariots. ⁵When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck twenty-two thousand men of the Syrians. ⁶Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David and brought tribute. The LORD gave victory to David wherever he went. ⁷David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem. ⁸From Tibhath and from Cun, cities of Hadadezer, David took very much bronze, with which Solomon made the bronze sea, the pillars, and the vessels of bronze. ⁹When Tou king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the army of Hadadezer king of Zobah, ¹⁰he sent Hadoram his son to King David to greet him and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and struck him (for Hadadezer had wars with Tou); and he had with him all kinds of vessels of gold and silver and bronze. ¹¹King David also dedicated these to the LORD, with the silver and the gold that he carried away from all the nations: from Edom, from Moab, from the children of Ammon, from the Philistines, and from Amalek. ¹²Moreover Abishai the son of Zeruiah struck eighteen thousand of the Edomites in the Valley of Salt. ¹³He put garrisons in Edom; and all the Edomites became servants to David. The LORD gave victory to David wherever he went. ¹⁴David reigned over all Israel; and he executed justice and righteousness for all his people. ¹⁵Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder; ¹⁶Zadok the son of Ahitub and Abimelech the son of Abiathar were priests; Shavsha was scribe; ¹⁷and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and the sons of David were chief officials serving the king.

¹⁹After this, Nahash the king of the children of Am-

mon died, and his son reigned in his place. ²David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun the son of Nahash, because his father showed kindness to me." So David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon to Hanun to comfort him. ³But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun, "Do you think that David honors your father, in that he has sent comforters to you? Haven't his servants come to you to search, to overthrow, and to spy out the land?" ⁴So Hanun took David's servants, shaved them, and cut off their garments in the middle at their buttocks, and sent them away. ⁵Then some people went and told David how the men were treated. He sent to meet them; for the men were greatly humiliated. The king said, "Stay at Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return." ⁶When the children of Ammon saw that they had made themselves odious to David, Hanun and the children of Ammon sent one thousand talents ^{xv} of silver to hire chariots and horsemen out of Mesopotamia, out of Aram-maacah, and out of Zobah. ⁷So they hired for themselves thirty-two thousand chariots, and the king of Maacah with his people, who came and encamped near Medeba. The children of Ammon gathered themselves together from their cities, and came to battle. ⁸When David heard of it, he sent Joab with all the army of the mighty men. ⁹The children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the gate of the city; and the kings who had come were by themselves in the field. ¹⁰Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose some of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians. ¹¹The rest of the people he committed into the hand of Abishai his brother; and they put themselves in array against the children of Ammon. ¹²He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you are to help me; but if the children of Ammon are too strong for you, then I will help you. ¹³Be courageous, and let's be strong for our people and for the cities of our God. May the LORD do that which seems good to him." ¹⁴So Joab and the people who were with him came near to the front of the Syrians to the battle; and they fled before him. ¹⁵When the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians had fled, they likewise fled before Abishai his brother, and entered into the city. Then Joab came to Jerusalem. ¹⁶When the Syrians saw that they were defeated by Israel, they sent messengers and called out the Syrians who were beyond the River, ^{xvi} with Shophach the captain of the army of Hadadezer leading them. ¹⁷David was told that, so he gathered all Israel together, passed over the Jordan, came to them, and set the battle in array against them. So when David had put the battle in array against the Syrians, they fought with him. ¹⁸The Syrians fled before Israel; and

David killed of the Syrian men seven thousand charioteers and forty thousand footmen, and also killed Shophach the captain of the army. ¹⁹When the servants of Hadadezer saw that they were defeated by Israel, they made peace with David and served him. The Syrians would not help the children of Ammon any more.

20At the time of the return of the year, at the time when kings go out, Joab led out the army and wasted the country of the children of Ammon, and came and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem. Joab struck Rabbah, and overthrew it. ²David took the crown of their king from off his head, and found it to weigh a talent of gold, ^{xvii} and there were precious stones in it. It was set on David's head, and he brought very much plunder out of the city. ³He brought out the people who were in it, and had them cut with saws, with iron picks, and with axes. David did so to all the cities of the children of Ammon. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem. ⁴After this, war arose at Gezer with the Philistines. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Sippai, of the sons of the giant; and they were subdued. ⁵Again there was war with the Philistines; and Elhanan the son of Jair killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver's beam. ⁶There was again war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, who had twenty-four fingers and toes, six on each hand and six on each foot; and he also was born to the giant. ⁷When he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea, David's brother, killed him. ⁸These were born to the giant in Gath; and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

21Satan stood up against Israel, and moved David to take a census of Israel. ²David said to Joab and to the princes of the people, "Go, count Israel from Beersheba even to Dan; and bring me word, that I may know how many there are." ³Joab said, "May the LORD make his people a hundred times as many as they are. But, my lord the king, aren't they all my lord's servants? Why does my lord require this thing? Why will he be a cause of guilt to Israel?" ⁴Nevertheless the king's word prevailed against Joab. Therefore Joab departed and went throughout all Israel, then came to Jerusalem. ⁵Joab gave the sum of the census of the people to David. All those of Israel were one million one hundred thousand men who drew a sword; and in Judah were four hundred seventy thousand men who drew a sword. ⁶But he didn't count Levi and Benjamin among them, for the king's word was abominable to Joab. ⁷God was displeased with this thing; therefore he struck Israel. ⁸David said to God, "I have sinned greatly, in that I have done this thing. But now put away, I beg you, the iniquity of your servant, for I have done very foolishly." ⁹The LORD spoke to Gad, David's seer, saying, ¹⁰"Go and

^{xv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds, so 1000 talents is about 30 metric tons

^{xvi}or, the Euphrates River

^{xvii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

Speak to David, saying, 'The LORD says, "I offer you three things. Choose one of them, that I may do it to you."' "

¹¹So Gad came to David and said to him, "The LORD says, 'Take your choice: ¹²either three years of famine; or three months to be consumed before your foes, while the sword of your enemies overtakes you; or else three days of the sword of the LORD, even pestilence in the land, and the LORD's angel destroying throughout all the borders of Israel. Now therefore consider what answer I shall return to him who sent me.' " ¹³David said to Gad, "I am in distress. Let me fall, I pray, into the LORD's hand, for his mercies are very great. Don't let me fall into man's hand." ¹⁴So the LORD sent a pestilence on Israel, and seventy thousand men of Israel fell. ¹⁵God sent an angel to Jerusalem to destroy it. As he was about to destroy, the LORD saw, and he relented of the disaster, and said to the destroying angel, "It is enough. Now withdraw your hand." the LORD's angel was standing by the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. ¹⁶David lifted up his eyes, and saw the LORD's angel standing between earth and the sky, having a drawn sword in his hand stretched out over Jerusalem. Then David and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fell on their faces. ¹⁷David said to God, "Isn't it I who commanded the people to be counted? It is even I who have sinned and done very wickedly; but these sheep, what have they done? Please let your hand, O LORD my God, be against me and against my father's house; but not against your people, that they should be plagued." ¹⁸Then the LORD's angel commanded Gad to tell David that David should go up and raise an altar to the LORD on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. ¹⁹David went up at the saying of Gad, which he spoke in the LORD's name. ²⁰Ornan turned back and saw the angel; and his four sons who were with him hid themselves. Now Ornan was threshing wheat. ²¹As David came to Ornan, Ornan looked and saw David, and went out of the threshing floor, and bowed himself to David with his face to the ground. ²²Then David said to Ornan, "Sell me the place of this threshing floor, that I may build an altar to the LORD on it. You shall sell it to me for the full price, that the plague may be stopped from afflicting the people." ²³Ornan said to David, "Take it for yourself, and let my lord the king do that which is good in his eyes. Behold, I give the oxen for burnt offerings, and the threshing instruments for wood, and the wheat for the meal offering. I give it all." ²⁴King David said to Ornan, "No, but I will most certainly buy it for the full price. For I will not take that which is yours for the LORD, nor offer a burnt offering that costs me nothing." ²⁵So David gave to Ornan six hundred shekels ^{xviii} of gold by weight for the place. ²⁶David built an altar to the LORD there, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings, and called on the LORD; and he answered him

from the sky by fire on the altar of burnt offering. ²⁷Then The LORD commanded the angel, and he put his sword back into its sheath. ²⁸At that time, when David saw that the LORD had answered him in the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite, then he sacrificed there. ²⁹For the LORD's tabernacle, which Moses made in the wilderness, and the altar of burnt offering, were at that time in the high place at Gibeon. ³⁰But David couldn't go before it to inquire of God, for he was afraid because of the sword of the LORD's angel.

22 Then David said, "This is the house of the LORD God, and this is the altar of burnt offering for Israel." ²David gave orders to gather together the foreigners who were in Eretz-Israel; and he set masons to cut dressed stones to build God's house. ³David prepared iron in abundance for the nails for the doors of the gates and for the couplings, and bronze in abundance without weight, ⁴and cedar trees without number, for the Sidonians and the people of Tyre brought cedar trees in abundance to David. ⁵David said, "Solomon my son is young and tender, and the house that is to be built for the LORD must be exceedingly magnificent, of fame and of glory throughout all countries. I will therefore make preparation for it." So David prepared abundantly before his death. ⁶Then he called for Solomon his son, and commanded him to build a house for the LORD, the God of Israel. ⁷David said to Solomon his son, "As for me, it was in my heart to build a house to the name of the LORD my God. ⁸But the LORD's word came to me, saying, 'You have shed blood abundantly and have made great wars. You shall not build a house to my name, because you have shed much blood on the earth in my sight. ⁹Behold, a son shall be born to you, who shall be a man of peace. I will give him rest from all his enemies all around; for his name shall be Solomon, and I will give peace and quietness to Israel in his days. ¹⁰He shall build a house for my name; and he will be my son, and I will be his father; and I will establish the throne of his kingdom over Israel forever.' ¹¹Now, my son, may the LORD be with you and prosper you, and build the house of the LORD your God, as he has spoken concerning you. ¹²May the LORD give you discretion and understanding, and put you in charge of Israel, so that you may keep the law of the LORD your God. ¹³Then you will prosper, if you observe to do the statutes and the ordinances which the LORD gave Moses concerning Israel. Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid and don't be dismayed. ¹⁴Now, behold, in my affliction I have prepared for the LORD's house one hundred thousand talents ^{xix} of gold, one million talents ^{xx} of silver, and bronze and iron without weight; for it is in abundance. I have also prepared timber and stone; and

^{xviii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels was about 6 kilograms or about 192 Troy ounces.

^{xix}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 100,000 talents is about 3 metric tons

^{xx}about 30,000 metric tons

you may add to them. ¹⁵There are also workmen with you in abundance—cutters and workers of stone and timber, and all kinds of men who are skillful in every kind of work; ¹⁶of the gold, the silver, the bronze, and the iron, there is no number. Arise and be doing, and may the LORD be with you.” ¹⁷David also commanded all the princes of Israel to help Solomon his son, saying, ¹⁸“Isn’t the LORD your God with you? Hasn’t he given you rest on every side? For he has delivered the inhabitants of the land into my hand; and the land is subdued before the LORD and before his people. ¹⁹Now set your heart and your soul to follow the LORD your God. Arise therefore, and build the sanctuary of the LORD God, to bring the ark of the LORD’s covenant and the holy vessels of God into the house that is to be built for the LORD’s name.”

23Now David was old and full of days; and he made Solomon his son king over Israel. ²He gathered together all the princes of Israel, with the priests and the Levites. ³The Levites were counted from thirty years old and upward; and their number by their polls, man by man, was thirty-eight thousand. ⁴David said, “Of these, twenty-four thousand were to oversee the work of the LORD’s house, six thousand were officers and judges, ⁵four thousand were doorkeepers, and four thousand praised the LORD with the instruments which I made for giving praise.” ⁶David divided them into divisions according to the sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. ⁷Of the Gershonites: Ladan and Shimei. ⁸The sons of Ladan: Jehiel the chief, Zetham, and Joel, three. ⁹The sons of Shimei: Shelomoth, Haziel, and Haran, three. These were the heads of the fathers’ households of Ladan. ¹⁰The sons of Shimei: Jahath, Zina, Jeush, and Beriah. These four were the sons of Shimei. ¹¹Jahath was the chief, and Zizah the second; but Jeush and Beriah didn’t have many sons; therefore they became a fathers’ house in one reckoning. ¹²The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel, four. ¹³The sons of Amram: Aaron and Moses; and Aaron was separated that he should sanctify the most holy things, he and his sons forever, to burn incense before the LORD, to minister to him, and to bless in his name forever. ¹⁴But as for Moses the man of God, his sons were named among the tribe of Levi. ¹⁵The sons of Moses: Gershom and Eliezer. ¹⁶The sons of Gershom: Shebuel the chief. ¹⁷The son of Eliezer was Rehabiah the chief; and Eliezer had no other sons, but the sons of Rehabiah were very many. ¹⁸The son of Izhar: Shelomith the chief. ¹⁹The sons of Hebron: Jeriah the chief, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth. ²⁰The sons of Uzziel: Micah the chief, and Isshiah the second. ²¹The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The sons of Mahli: Eleazar and Kish. ²²Eleazar died, and had no sons, but daughters only; and their relatives, the sons of Kish, took them as wives. ²³The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jeremoth, three. ²⁴These were the sons

of Levi after their fathers’ houses, even the heads of the fathers’ houses of those who were counted individually, in the number of names by their polls, who did the work for the service of the LORD’s house, from twenty years old and upward. ²⁵For David said, “The LORD, the God of Israel, has given rest to his people; and he dwells in Jerusalem forever. ²⁶Also the Levites will no longer need to carry the tabernacle and all its vessels for its service.” ²⁷For by the last words of David the sons of Levi were counted, from twenty years old and upward. ²⁸For their duty was to wait on the sons of Aaron for the service of the LORD’s house—in the courts, in the rooms, and in the purifying of all holy things, even the work of the service of God’s house; ²⁹for the show bread also, and for the fine flour for a meal offering, whether of unleavened wafers, or of that which is baked in the pan, or of that which is soaked, and for all measurements of quantity and size; ³⁰and to stand every morning to thank and praise the LORD, and likewise in the evening; ³¹and to offer all burnt offerings to the LORD on the Sabbaths, on the new moons, and on the set feasts, in number according to the ordinance concerning them, continually before the LORD; ³²and that they should keep the duty of the Tent of Meeting, the duty of the holy place, and the duty of the sons of Aaron their brothers for the service of the LORD’s house.

24These were the divisions of the sons of Aaron. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar. ²But Nadab and Abihu died before their father, and had no children; therefore Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests. ³David, with Zadok of the sons of Eleazar and Ahimelech of the sons of Ithamar, divided them according to their ordering in their service. ⁴There were more chief men found of the sons of Eleazar than of the sons of Ithamar; and they were divided like this: of the sons of Eleazar there were sixteen, heads of fathers’ houses; and of the sons of Ithamar, according to their fathers’ houses, eight. ⁵Thus they were divided impartially by drawing lots; for there were princes of the sanctuary and princes of God, both of the sons of Eleazar, and of the sons of Ithamar. ⁶Shemaiah the son of Nethanel the scribe, who was of the Levites, wrote them in the presence of the king, the princes, Zadok the priest, Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, and the heads of the fathers’ households of the priests and of the Levites; one fathers’ house being taken for Eleazar, and one taken for Ithamar. ⁷Now the first lot came out to Jehoiarib, the second to Jedaiah, ⁸the third to Harim, the fourth to Seorim, ⁹the fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to Mijamin, ¹⁰the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah, ¹¹the ninth to Yeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah, ¹²the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim, ¹³the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab, ¹⁴the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer, ¹⁵the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Hap-pizzaz, ¹⁶the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to

Jehezkel, ¹⁷the twenty-first to Jachin, the twenty-second to Gamul, ¹⁸the twenty-third to Delaiah, and the twenty-fourth to Maaziah. ¹⁹This was their ordering in their service, to come into the LORD's house according to the ordinance given to them by Aaron their father, as the LORD, the God of Israel, had commanded him. ²⁰Of the rest of the sons of Levi: of the sons of Amram, Shubael; of the sons of Shubael, Jehdeiah. ²¹Of Rehabiah: of the sons of Rehabiah, Isshiah the chief. ²²Of the Izharites, Shelomoth; of the sons of Shelomoth, Jahath. ²³The sons of Hebron: Jeriah, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth. ²⁴The sons of Uzziel: Micah; of the sons of Micah, Shamir. ²⁵The brother of Micah: Isshiah; of the sons of Isshiah, Zechariah. ²⁶The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The son of Jaaziah: Beno. ²⁷The sons of Merari by Jaaziah: Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri. ²⁸Of Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons. ²⁹Of Kish, the son of Kish: Jerahmeel. ³⁰The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites after their fathers' houses. ³¹These likewise cast lots even as their brothers the sons of Aaron in the presence of David the king, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers' households of the priests and of the Levites, the fathers' households of the chief even as those of his younger brother.

²⁵Moreover, David and the captains of the army set apart for the service certain of the sons of Asaph, of Heman, and of Jeduthun, who were to prophesy with harps, with stringed instruments, and with cymbals. The number of those who did the work according to their service was: ²of the sons of Asaph: Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asharelah. The sons of Asaph were under the hand of Asaph, who prophesied at the order of the king. ³Of Jeduthun, the sons of Jeduthun: Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah, six, under the hands of their father Jeduthun, who prophesied in giving thanks and praising the LORD with the harp. ⁴Of Heman, the sons of Heman: Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth. ⁵All these were the sons of Heman the king's seer in the words of God, to lift up the horn. God gave to Heman fourteen sons and three daughters. ⁶All these were under the hands of their father for song in the LORD's house, with cymbals, stringed instruments, and harps, for the service of God's house: Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman being under the order of the king. ⁷The number of them, with their brothers who were instructed in singing to the LORD, even all who were skillful, was two hundred eighty-eight. ⁸They cast lots for their offices, all alike, the small as well as the great, the teacher as well as the student. ⁹Now the first lot came out for Asaph to Joseph; the second to Gedaliah, he and his brothers and sons were twelve; ¹⁰the third to Zaccur, his sons and

his brothers, twelve; ¹¹the fourth to Izri, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹²the fifth to Nethaniah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹³the sixth to Bukkiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁴the seventh to Jesharelah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁵the eighth to Jeshaiiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁶the ninth to Mattaniah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁷the tenth to Shimei, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁸the eleventh to Azarel, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ¹⁹the twelfth to Hashabiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁰for the thirteenth, Shubael, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²¹for the fourteenth, Mattithiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²²for the fifteenth to Jeremoth, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²³for the sixteenth to Hananiah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁴for the seventeenth to Joshbekashah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁵for the eighteenth to Hanani, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁶for the nineteenth to Mallothi, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁷for the twentieth to Eliathah, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁸for the twenty-first to Hothir, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ²⁹for the twenty-second to Giddalti, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ³⁰for the twenty-third to Mahazioth, his sons and his brothers, twelve; ³¹for the twenty-fourth to Romamti-Ezer, his sons and his brothers, twelve.

²⁶For the divisions of the doorkeepers: of the Korahites, Meshelemiah the son of Kore, of the sons of Asaph. ²Meshelemiah had sons: Zechariah the firstborn, Jediahel the second, Zebadiah the third, Jathniel the fourth, ³Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth, and Eliehoenai the seventh. ⁴Obed-Edom had sons: Shemaiah the firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the third, Sacar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth, ⁵Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, and Peul-lethai the eighth; for God blessed him. ⁶Sons were also born to Shemaiah his son, who ruled over the house of their father; for they were mighty men of valor. ⁷The sons of Shemaiah: Othni, Rephael, Obed, and Elzabad, whose relatives were valiant men, Elihu, and Semachiah. ⁸All these were of the sons of Obed-Edom with their sons and their brothers, able men in strength for the service: sixty-two of Obed-Edom. ⁹Meshelemiah had sons and brothers, eighteen valiant men. ¹⁰Also Hosah, of the children of Merari, had sons: Shimri the chief (for though he was not the firstborn, yet his father made him chief), ¹¹Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the third, and Zechariah the fourth. All the sons and brothers of Hosah were thirteen. ¹²Of these were the divisions of the doorkeepers, even of the chief men, having offices like their brothers, to minister in the LORD's house. ¹³They cast lots, the small as well as the great, according to their fathers' houses, for every gate. ¹⁴The lot eastward fell to Shelemiah. Then for Zechariah his son, a wise counselor, they cast lots; and his lot came out northward. ¹⁵To Obed-Edom southward; and to his sons the storehouse. ¹⁶To Shuppim and Hosah westward, by the gate of

Shallecheth, at the causeway that goes up, watchman opposite watchman. ¹⁷Eastward were six Levites, northward four a day, southward four a day, and for the storehouse two and two. ¹⁸For Parbar westward, four at the causeway, and two at Parbar. ¹⁹These were the divisions of the doorkeepers; of the sons of the Korahites, and of the sons of Merari. ²⁰Of the Levites, Ahijah was over the treasures of God's house and over the treasures of the dedicated things. ²¹The sons of Ladan, the sons of the Gershonites belonging to Ladan, the heads of the fathers' households belonging to Ladan the Gershonite: Jehieli. ²²The sons of Jehieli: Zetham, and Joel his brother, over the treasures of the LORD's house. ²³Of the Amramites, of the Izharites, of the Hebronites, of the Uzzielites: ²⁴Shebuel the son of Gershom, the son of Moses, was ruler over the treasuries. ²⁵His brothers: of Eliezer, Rehabiah his son, and Jeshiah his son, and Joram his son, and Zichri his son, and Shelomoth his son. ²⁶This Shelomoth and his brothers were over all the treasuries of the dedicated things, which David the king, and the heads of the fathers' households, the captains over thousands and hundreds, and the captains of the army, had dedicated. ²⁷They dedicated some of the plunder won in battles to repair the LORD's house. ²⁸All that Samuel the seer, Saul the son of Kish, Abner the son of Ner, and Joab the son of Zeruiah had dedicated, whoever had dedicated anything, it was under the hand of Shelomoth and of his brothers. ²⁹Of the Izharites, Chenaniah and his sons were appointed to the outward business over Israel, for officers and judges. ³⁰Of the Hebronites, Hashabiah and his brothers, one thousand seven hundred men of valor, had the oversight of Israel beyond the Jordan westward, for all the business of the LORD and for the service of the king. ³¹Of the Hebronites, Jerijah was the chief of the Hebronites, according to their generations by fathers' households. They were sought for in the fortieth year of the reign of David, and mighty men of valor were found among them at Jazer of Gilead. ³²His relatives, men of valor, were two thousand seven hundred, heads of fathers' households, whom King David made overseers over the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of the Manassites, for every matter pertaining to God and for the affairs of the king.

27 Now the children of Israel after their number, the heads of fathers' households and the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and their officers who served the king in any matter of the divisions which came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year—of every division were twenty-four thousand. ²Over the first division for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ³He was of the children of Perez, the chief of all the captains of the army for the first month. ⁴Over the division of the second month was Dodai the Ahohite and his division, and

Mikloth the ruler; and in his division were twenty-four thousand. ⁵The third captain of the army for the third month was Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada the chief priest. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ⁶This is that Benaiah who was the mighty man of the thirty and over the thirty. Of his division was Ammizabad his son. ⁷The fourth captain for the fourth month was Asahel the brother of Joab, and Zebadiah his son after him. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ⁸The fifth captain for the fifth month was Shamhuth the Izrahite. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ⁹The sixth captain for the sixth month was Ira the son of Ikesh the Tekoite. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹⁰The seventh captain for the seventh month was Helez the Pelonite, of the children of Ephraim. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹¹The eighth captain for the eighth month was Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the Zerahites. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹²The ninth captain for the ninth month was Abiezer the Anathothite, of the Benjamites. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹³The tenth captain for the tenth month was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zerahites. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹⁴The eleventh captain for the eleventh month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the children of Ephraim. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹⁵The twelfth captain for the twelfth month was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel. In his division were twenty-four thousand. ¹⁶Furthermore over the tribes of Israel: of the Reubenites, Eliezer the son of Zichri was the ruler; of the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maacah; ¹⁷of Levi, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel; of Aaron, Zadok; ¹⁸of Judah, Elihu, one of the brothers of David; of Issachar, Omri the son of Michael; ¹⁹of Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah; of Naphtali, Jeremoth the son of Azriel; ²⁰of the children of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah; of the half-tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedai; ²¹of the half-tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah; of Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner; ²²of Dan, Azarel the son of Jeroham. These were the captains of the tribes of Israel. ²³But David didn't take the number of them from twenty years old and under, because the LORD had said he would increase Israel like the stars of the sky. ²⁴Joab the son of Zeruiah began to take a census, but didn't finish; and wrath came on Israel for this. The number wasn't put into the account in the chronicles of King David. ²⁵Over the king's treasures was Azmaveth the son of Adiel. Over the treasures in the fields, in the cities, in the villages, and in the towers was Jonathan the son of Uziah; ²⁶Over those who did the work of the field for tillage of the ground was Ezri the son of Chelub. ²⁷Over the vineyards was Shimei the Ramathite. Over the increase of the vineyards for the wine cellars was Zabdi the Shiphmite. ²⁸Over the olive trees and the sycamore trees that were in the lowland was Baal Hanan the Gederite. Over the cellars of oil was Joash. ²⁹Over

the herds that fed in Sharon was Shitrai the Sharonite. Over the herds that were in the valleys was Shaphat the son of Adlai. ³⁰Over the camels was Obil the Ishmaelite. Over the donkeys was Jehdeiah the Meronothite. Over the flocks was Jaziz the Hagrite. ³¹All these were the rulers of the property which was King David's. ³²Also Jonathan, David's uncle, was a counselor, a man of understanding, and a scribe. Jehiel the son of Hachmoni was with the king's sons. ³³Ahithophel was the king's counselor. Hushai the Archite was the king's friend. ³⁴After Ahithophel was Jehoiada the son of Benaiah, and Abiathar. Joab was the captain of the king's army.

28David assembled all the princes of Israel, the princes of the tribes, the captains of the companies who served the king by division, the captains of thousands, the captains of hundreds, and the rulers over all the substance and possessions of the king and of his sons, with the officers and the mighty men, even all the mighty men of valor, to Jerusalem. ²Then David the king stood up on his feet and said, "Hear me, my brothers and my people! As for me, it was in my heart to build a house of rest for the ark of the LORD's covenant, and for the footstool of our God; and I had prepared for the building. ³But God said to me, 'You shall not build a house for my name, because you are a man of war and have shed blood.' ⁴However the LORD, the God of Israel, chose me out of all the house of my father to be king over Israel forever. For he has chosen Judah to be prince; and in the house of Judah, the house of my father; and among the sons of my father he took pleasure in me to make me king over all Israel. ⁵Of all my sons (for the LORD has given me many sons), he has chosen Solomon my son to sit on the throne of the LORD's kingdom over Israel. ⁶He said to me, 'Solomon, your son, shall build my house and my courts; for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father. ⁷I will establish his kingdom forever if he continues to do my commandments and my ordinances, as it is today.' ⁸Now therefore, in the sight of all Israel, the LORD's assembly, and in the audience of our God, observe and seek out all the commandments of the LORD your God, that you may possess this good land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children after you forever. ⁹You, Solomon my son, know the God of your father, and serve him with a perfect heart and with a willing mind; for the LORD searches all hearts, and understands all the imaginations of the thoughts. If you seek him, he will be found by you; but if you forsake him, he will cast you off forever. ¹⁰Take heed now, for the LORD has chosen you to build a house for the sanctuary. Be strong, and do it." ¹¹Then David gave to Solomon his son the plans for the porch of the temple, for its houses, for its treasuries, for its upper rooms, for its inner rooms, for the place of the mercy seat; ¹²and the plans of all that he had by the Spirit, for the courts of the LORD's house,

for all the surrounding rooms, for the treasuries of God's house, and for the treasuries of the dedicated things; ¹³also for the divisions of the priests and the Levites, for all the work of the service of the LORD's house, and for all the vessels of service in the LORD's house— ¹⁴of gold by weight for the gold for all vessels of every kind of service, for all the vessels of silver by weight, for all vessels of every kind of service; ¹⁵by weight also for the lamp stands of gold, and for its lamps, of gold, by weight for every lamp stand and for its lamps; and for the lamp stands of silver, by weight for every lamp stand and for its lamps, according to the use of every lamp stand; ¹⁶and the gold by weight for the tables of show bread, for every table; and silver for the tables of silver; ¹⁷and the forks, the basins, and the cups, of pure gold; and for the golden bowls by weight for every bowl; and for the silver bowls by weight for every bowl; ¹⁸and for the altar of incense, refined gold by weight; and gold for the plans for the chariot, and the cherubim that spread out and cover the ark of the LORD's covenant. ¹⁹"All this", David said, "I have been made to understand in writing from the LORD's hand, even all the works of this pattern." ²⁰David said to Solomon his son, "Be strong and courageous, and do it. Don't be afraid, nor be dismayed, for the LORD God, even my God, is with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you, until all the work for the service of the LORD's house is finished. ²¹Behold, there are the divisions of the priests and the Levites for all the service of God's house. Every willing man who has skill for any kind of service shall be with you in all kinds of work. Also the captains and all the people will be entirely at your command."

29David the king said to all the assembly, "Solomon my son, whom alone God has chosen, is yet young and tender, and the work is great; for the palace is not for man, but for the LORD God. ²Now I have prepared with all my might for the house of my God the gold for the things of gold, the silver for the things of silver, the bronze for the things of bronze, iron for the things of iron, and wood for the things of wood, also onyx stones, stones to be set, stones for inlaid work of various colors, all kinds of precious stones, and marble stones in abundance. ³In addition, because I have set my affection on the house of my God, since I have a treasure of my own of gold and silver, I give it to the house of my God, over and above all that I have prepared for the holy house: ⁴even three thousand talents of gold, ^{xxi} of the gold of Ophir, and seven thousand talents ^{xxii} of refined silver, with which to overlay the walls of the houses; ⁵of gold for the things of gold, and of silver for the things of silver, and for all kinds of work to be made by the hands of artisans. Who then offers willingly to con-

^{xxi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 3000 talents is about 90 metric tons

^{xxii}about 210 metric tons

secrete himself today to the LORD?” ⁶Then the princes of the fathers’ households, and the princes of the tribes of Israel, and the captains of thousands and of hundreds, with the rulers over the king’s work, offered willingly; ⁷and they gave for the service of God’s house of gold five thousand talents ^{xxiii} and ten thousand darics, ^{xxiv} of silver ten thousand talents, of bronze eighteen thousand talents, and of iron one hundred thousand talents. ⁸People with whom precious stones were found gave them to the treasure of the LORD’s house, under the hand of Jehiel the Gershonite. ⁹Then the people rejoiced, because they offered willingly, because with a perfect heart they offered willingly to the LORD; and David the king also rejoiced with great joy. ¹⁰Therefore David blessed the LORD before all the assembly; and David said, “You are blessed, LORD, the God of Israel our father, forever and ever. ¹¹Yours, LORD, is the greatness, the power, the glory, the victory, and the majesty! For all that is in the heavens and in the earth is yours. Yours is the kingdom, LORD, and you are exalted as head above all. ¹²Both riches and honor come from you, and you rule over all! In your hand is power and might! It is in your hand to make great, and to give strength to all! ¹³Now therefore, our God, we thank you and praise your glorious name. ¹⁴But who am I, and what is my people, that we should be able to offer so willingly as this? For all things come from you, and we have given you of your own. ¹⁵For we are strangers before you and foreigners, as all our fathers were. Our days on the earth are as a shadow, and there is no remaining. ¹⁶LORD our God, all this store that we have prepared to build you a house for your holy name comes from your hand, and is all your own. ¹⁷I know also, my God, that you try the heart and have pleasure in uprightness. As for me, in the uprightness of my heart I have willingly offered all these things. Now I have seen with joy your people, who are present here, offer willingly to you. ¹⁸LORD, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this desire forever in the thoughts of the heart of your people, and prepare their heart for you; ¹⁹and give to Solomon my son a perfect heart, to keep your commandments, your testimonies, and your statutes, and to do all these things, and to build the palace, for which I have made provision.” ²⁰Then David said to all the assembly, “Now bless the LORD your God!” All the assembly blessed the LORD, the God of their fathers, and bowed down their heads and prostrated themselves before the LORD and the king. ²¹They sacrificed sacrifices to the LORD and offered burnt offerings to the LORD on the next day after that day, even one thousand bulls, one thousand rams, and one thousand lambs, with their drink offerings and sacrifices in abundance for all Israel, ²²and

ate and drank before the LORD on that day with great gladness. They made Solomon the son of David king the second time, and anointed him before the LORD to be prince, and Zadok to be priest. ²³Then Solomon sat on the throne of the LORD as king instead of David his father, and prospered; and all Israel obeyed him. ²⁴All the princes, the mighty men, and also all of the sons of King David submitted themselves to Solomon the king. ²⁵The LORD magnified Solomon exceedingly in the sight of all Israel, and gave to him such royal majesty as had not been on any king before him in Israel. ²⁶Now David the son of Jesse reigned over all Israel. ²⁷The time that he reigned over Israel was forty years; he reigned seven years in Hebron, and he reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem. ²⁸He died at a good old age, full of days, riches, and honor; and Solomon his son reigned in his place. ²⁹Now the acts of David the king, first and last, behold, they are written in the history of Samuel the seer, and in the history of Nathan the prophet, and in the history of Gad the seer, ³⁰with all his reign and his might, and the events that involved him, Israel, and all the kingdoms of the lands.

^{xxiii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 5000 talents is about 150 metric tons

^{xxiv}a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

2 Chronicles

¹Solomon the son of David was firmly established in his kingdom, and the LORD ⁱ his God ⁱⁱ was with him, and made him exceedingly great. ²Solomon spoke to all Israel, to the captains of thousands and of hundreds, to the judges, and to every prince in all Israel, the heads of the fathers' households. ³Then Solomon, and all the assembly with him, went to the high place that was at Gibeon; for God's Tent of Meeting was there, which the LORD's servant Moses had made in the wilderness. ⁴But David had brought God's ark up from Kiriath Jearim to the place that David had prepared for it; for he had pitched a tent for it at Jerusalem. ⁵Moreover the bronze altar that Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, had made was there before the LORD's tabernacle; and Solomon and the assembly were seeking counsel there. ⁶Solomon went up there to the bronze altar before the LORD, which was at the Tent of Meeting, and offered one thousand burnt offerings on it. ⁷That night, God appeared to Solomon and said to him, "Ask for what you want me to give you." ⁸Solomon said to God, "You have shown great loving kindness to David my father, and have made me king in his place. ⁹Now, LORD God, let your promise to David my father be established; for you have made me king over a people like the dust of the earth in multitude. ¹⁰Now give me wisdom and knowledge, that I may go out and come in before this people; for who can judge this great people of yours?" ¹¹God said to Solomon, "Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king, ¹²therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have." ¹³So Solomon came from the high place that was at Gibeon, from before the Tent of Meeting, to Jerusalem; and he reigned over Israel. ¹⁴Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen. He had one thousand four hundred chariots and twelve thousand horse-

men that he placed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem. ¹⁵The king made silver and gold to be as common as stones in Jerusalem, and he made cedars to be as common as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland. ¹⁶The horses which Solomon had were brought out of Egypt and from Kue. The king's merchants purchased them from Kue. ¹⁷They imported from Egypt then exported a chariot for six hundred pieces of silver and a horse for one hundred fifty. ⁱⁱⁱ They also exported them to the Hittite kings and the Syrian ^{iv} kings.

²Now Solomon decided to build a house for the LORD's name, and a house for his kingdom. ²Solomon counted out seventy thousand men to bear burdens, eighty thousand men who were stone cutters in the mountains, and three thousand six hundred to oversee them. ³Solomon sent to Hiram the king of Tyre, saying, "As you dealt with David my father, and sent him cedars to build him a house in which to dwell, so deal with me. ⁴Behold, ^v I am about to build a house for the name of the LORD my God, to dedicate it to him, to burn before him incense of sweet spices, for the continual show bread, and for the burnt offerings morning and evening, on the Sabbaths, on the new moons, and on the set feasts of the LORD our God. This is an ordinance forever to Israel. ⁵"The house which I am building will be great, for our God is greater than all gods. ⁶But who is able to build him a house, since heaven and the heaven of heavens can't contain him? Who am I then, that I should build him a house, except just to burn incense before him? ⁷"Now therefore send me a man skillful to work in gold, in silver, in bronze, in iron, and in purple, crimson, and blue, and who knows how to engrave engravings, to be with the skillful men who are with me in Judah and in Jerusalem, whom David my father provided. ⁸"Send me also cedar trees, cypress trees, and algum trees out of Lebanon, for I know that your servants know how to cut timber in Lebanon. Behold, my servants

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱThe pieces of silver were probably shekels, so 600 pieces would be about 13.2 pounds or 6 kilograms of silver, and 150 would be about 3.3 pounds or 1.5 kilograms of silver.

^{iv}or, Aramean

^v"Behold", from , " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

will be with your servants, ⁹even to prepare me timber in abundance; for the house which I am about to build will be great and wonderful. ¹⁰Behold, I will give to your servants, the cutters who cut timber, twenty thousand cors ^{vi} of beaten wheat, twenty thousand baths ^{vii} of barley, twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil.” ¹¹Then Hiram the king of Tyre answered in writing, which he sent to Solomon, “Because the LORD loves his people, he has made you king over them.” ¹²Hiram continued, “Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who made heaven and earth, who has given to David the king a wise son, endowed with discretion and understanding, who would build a house for the LORD and a house for his kingdom. ¹³Now I have sent a skillful man, endowed with understanding, Hiram-abi, ^{viii} ¹⁴the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan; and his father was a man of Tyre. He is skillful to work in gold, in silver, in bronze, in iron, in stone, in timber, in purple, in blue, in fine linen, and in crimson, also to engrave any kind of engraving and to devise any device, that there may be a place appointed to him with your skillful men, and with the skillful men of my lord David your father. ¹⁵“Now therefore, the wheat, the barley, the oil, and the wine which my lord has spoken of, let him send to his servants; ¹⁶and we will cut wood out of Lebanon, as much as you need. We will bring it to you in rafts by sea to Joppa; then you shall carry it up to Jerusalem.” ¹⁷Solomon counted all the foreigners who were in Eretz-Israel, after the census with which David his father had counted them; and they found one hundred fifty-three thousand six hundred. ¹⁸He set seventy thousand of them to bear burdens, eighty thousand who were stone cutters in the mountains, and three thousand six hundred overseers to assign the people their work.

³Then Solomon began to build the LORD’s house at Jerusalem on Mount Moriah, where the LORD appeared to David his father, which he prepared in the place that David had appointed, on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite. ²He began to build in the second day of the second month, in the fourth year of his reign. ³Now these are the foundations which Solomon laid for the building of God’s house: the length by cubits ^{ix} after the first measure was sixty cubits, and the width twenty cubits. ⁴The porch that was in front, its length, across the width of the house, was twenty cubits, and the height one hundred twenty; and he overlaid it within with pure gold. ⁵He made the larger

room with a ceiling of cypress wood, which he overlaid with fine gold, and ornamented it with palm trees and chains. ⁶He decorated the house with precious stones for beauty. The gold was gold from Parvaim. ⁷He also overlaid the house, the beams, the thresholds, its walls, and its doors with gold, and engraved cherubim on the walls. ⁸He made the most holy place. Its length, according to the width of the house, was twenty cubits, and its width twenty cubits; and he overlaid it with fine gold, amounting to six hundred talents. ^x ⁹The weight of the nails was fifty shekels ^{xi} of gold. He overlaid the upper rooms with gold. ¹⁰In the most holy place he made two cherubim by carving, and they overlaid them with gold. ¹¹The wings of the cherubim were twenty cubits long: the wing of the one was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house; and the other wing was five cubits, reaching to the wing of the other cherub. ¹²The wing of the other cherub was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the house; and the other wing was five cubits, joining to the wing of the other cherub. ¹³The wings of these cherubim spread themselves out twenty cubits. They stood on their feet, and their faces were toward the house. ¹⁴He made the veil of blue, purple, crimson, and fine linen, and ornamented it with cherubim. ¹⁵Also he made before the house two pillars thirty-five cubits high, and the capital that was on the top of each of them was five cubits. ¹⁶He made chains in the inner sanctuary, and put them on the tops of the pillars; and he made one hundred pomegranates, and put them on the chains. ¹⁷He set up the pillars before the temple, one on the right hand and the other on the left; and called the name of that on the right hand Jachin, and the name of that on the left Boaz.

⁴Then he made an altar of bronze, twenty cubits ^{xii} long, twenty cubits wide, and ten cubits high. ²Also he made the molten sea ^{xiii} of ten cubits from brim to brim. It was round, five cubits high, and thirty cubits in circumference. ³Under it was the likeness of oxen, which encircled it, for ten cubits, encircling the sea. The oxen were in two rows, cast when it was cast. ⁴It stood on twelve oxen, three looking toward the north, three looking toward the west, three looking toward the south, and three looking toward the east; and the sea was set on them above, and all their hindquarters were inward. ⁵It was a handbreadth thick. Its brim was made like the brim of a cup, like the flower of a lily. It received and held three thousand baths. ^{xiv} ⁶He also made ten basins, and put five on the right

^{vi}1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels, so 20,000 cors of wheat would weigh about 545 metric tons

^{vii}1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters or 2.4 pecks. 20,000 baths of barley would weigh about 262 metric tons.

^{viii}or, Hiram, my father

^{ix}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^xA talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 600 talents is about 18 metric tons

^{xi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 50 shekels was about 0.5 kilograms or about 16 Troy ounces.

^{xii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xiii}or, pool, or, reservoir

^{xiv}A bath is about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21.1 liters, so 3,000 baths is about 16,800 gallons or 63.3 kiloliters.

hand and five on the left, to wash in them. The things that belonged to the burnt offering were washed in them, but the sea was for the priests to wash in. ⁷He made the ten lamp stands of gold according to the ordinance concerning them; and he set them in the temple, five on the right hand and five on the left. ⁸He made also ten tables, and placed them in the temple, five on the right side and five on the left. He made one hundred basins of gold. ⁹Furthermore he made the court of the priests, the great court, and doors for the court, and overlaid their doors with bronze. ¹⁰He set the sea on the right side of the house eastward, toward the south. ¹¹Huram made the pots, the shovels, and the basins. So Huram finished doing the work that he did for King Solomon in God's house: ¹²the two pillars, the bowls, the two capitals which were on the top of the pillars, the two networks to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the top of the pillars, ¹³and the four hundred pomegranates for the two networks—two rows of pomegranates for each network, to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the pillars. ¹⁴He also made the bases, and he made the basins on the bases— ¹⁵one sea, and the twelve oxen under it. ¹⁶Huram-abi ^{xv} also made the pots, the shovels, the forks, and all its vessels for King Solomon, for the LORD's house, of bright bronze. ¹⁷The king cast them in the plain of the Jordan, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zeredah. ¹⁸Thus Solomon made all these vessels in great abundance, so that the weight of the bronze could not be determined. ¹⁹Solomon made all the vessels that were in God's house: the golden altar, the tables with the show bread on them, ²⁰and the lamp stands with their lamps to burn according to the ordinance before the inner sanctuary, of pure gold; ²¹and the flowers, the lamps, and the tongs of gold that was purest gold; ²²and the snuffers, the basins, the spoons, and the fire pans of pure gold. As for the entry of the house, its inner doors for the most holy place and the doors of the main hall of the temple were of gold.

⁵Thus all the work that Solomon did for the LORD's house was finished. Solomon brought in the things that David his father had dedicated, even the silver, the gold, and all the vessels, and put them in the treasuries of God's house. ²Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel and all the heads of the tribes, the princes of the fathers' households of the children of Israel, to Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the LORD's covenant out of David's city, which is Zion. ³So all the men of Israel assembled themselves to the king at the feast, which was in the seventh month. ⁴All the elders of Israel came. The Levites took up the ark. ⁵They brought up the ark, the Tent of Meeting, and all the holy vessels that were in the Tent. The Levitical priests brought these up. ⁶King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel who were assembled to him were before the ark,

sacrificing sheep and cattle that could not be counted or numbered for multitude. ⁷The priests brought in the ark of the LORD's covenant to its place, into the inner sanctuary of the house, to the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubim. ⁸For the cherubim spread out their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its poles above. ⁹The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the ark in front of the inner sanctuary, but they were not seen outside; and it is there to this day. ¹⁰There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets which Moses put there at Horeb, when the LORD made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt. ¹¹When the priests had come out of the holy place (for all the priests who were present had sanctified themselves, and didn't keep their divisions; ¹²also the Levites who were the singers, all of them, even Asaph, Heman, Jeduthun, and their sons and their brothers, arrayed in fine linen, with cymbals and stringed instruments and harps, stood at the east end of the altar, and with them one hundred twenty priests sounding with shofars ^{xvi}); or, trumpets ¹³when the trumpeters and singers were as one, to make one sound to be heard in praising and thanking the LORD; and when they lifted up their voice with the shofars ^{xvii} or, trumpets and cymbals and instruments of music, and praised the LORD, saying, "For he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever!" then the house was filled with a cloud, even the LORD's house, ¹⁴so that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud; for the LORD's glory filled God's house.

⁶Then Solomon said, "The LORD has said that he would dwell in the thick darkness. ²But I have built you a house and home, a place for you to dwell in forever." ³The king turned his face, and blessed all the assembly of Israel; and all the assembly of Israel stood. ⁴He said, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to David my father, and has with his hands fulfilled it, saying, ⁵'Since the day that I brought my people out of the land of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel to build a house in, that my name might be there, and I chose no man to be prince over my people Israel; ⁶but now I have chosen Jerusalem, that my name might be there; and I have chosen David to be over my people Israel.' ⁷Now it was in the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel. ⁸But the LORD said to David my father, 'Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart; ⁹nevertheless you shall not build the house, but your son who will come out of your body, he shall build the house for my name.' ¹⁰"The LORD has performed his word that he spoke; for I have risen up in the place of David my father, and sit on the throne of Israel, as the

^{xv}"abi" means "his father"

^{xvi}or, trumpets);
^{xvii}or, trumpets

LORD promised, and have built the house for the name of the LORD, the God of Israel. ¹¹There I have set the ark, in which is the LORD's covenant, which he made with the children of Israel." ¹²He stood before the LORD's altar in the presence of all the assembly of Israel, and spread out his hands ¹³(for Solomon had made a bronze platform, five cubits ^{xviii} long, five cubits wide, and three cubits high, and had set it in the middle of the court; and he stood on it, and knelt down on his knees before all the assembly of Israel, and spread out his hands toward heaven). ¹⁴Then he said, "LORD, the God of Israel, there is no God like you in heaven or on earth—you who keep covenant and loving kindness with your servants who walk before you with all their heart; ¹⁵who have kept with your servant David my father that which you promised him. Yes, you spoke with your mouth, and have fulfilled it with your hand, as it is today. ¹⁶"Now therefore, LORD, the God of Israel, keep with your servant David my father that which you have promised him, saying, 'There shall not fail you a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel, if only your children take heed to their way, to walk in my law as you have walked before me.' ¹⁷Now therefore, LORD, the God of Israel, let your word be verified, which you spoke to your servant David. ¹⁸"But will God indeed dwell with men on the earth? Behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens can't contain you; how much less this house which I have built! ¹⁹Yet have respect for the prayer of your servant and to his supplication, LORD my God, to listen to the cry and to the prayer which your servant prays before you; ²⁰that your eyes may be open toward this house day and night, even toward the place where you have said that you would put your name, to listen to the prayer which your servant will pray toward this place. ²¹Listen to the petitions of your servant and of your people Israel, when they pray toward this place. Yes, hear from your dwelling place, even from heaven; and when you hear, forgive. ²²"If a man sins against his neighbor, and an oath is laid on him to cause him to swear, and he comes and swears before your altar in this house, ²³then hear from heaven, act, and judge your servants, bringing retribution to the wicked, to bring his way on his own head; and justifying the righteous, to give him according to his righteousness. ²⁴"If your people Israel are struck down before the enemy because they have sinned against you, and they turn again and confess your name, and pray and make supplication before you in this house, ²⁵then hear from heaven, and forgive the sin of your people Israel, and bring them again to the land which you gave to them and to their fathers. ²⁶"When the sky is shut up and there is no rain because they have sinned against you, if they pray toward this place and confess your name, and turn from their sin when you afflict them, ²⁷then hear in heaven, and forgive the sin of your servants, your peo-

ple Israel, when you teach them the good way in which they should walk, and send rain on your land, which you have given to your people for an inheritance. ²⁸"If there is famine in the land, if there is pestilence, if there is blight or mildew, locust or caterpillar; if their enemies besiege them in the land of their cities; whatever plague or whatever sickness there is— ²⁹whatever prayer and supplication is made by any man, or by all your people Israel, who will each know his own plague and his own sorrow, and shall spread out his hands toward this house, ³⁰then hear from heaven your dwelling place and forgive, and render to every man according to all his ways, whose heart you know (for you, even you only, know the hearts of the children of men), ³¹that they may fear you, to walk in your ways as long as they live in the land which you gave to our fathers. ³²"Moreover, concerning the foreigner, who is not of your people Israel, when he comes from a far country for your great name's sake and your mighty hand and your outstretched arm, when they come and pray toward this house, ³³then hear from heaven, even from your dwelling place, and do according to all that the foreigner calls to you for; that all the peoples of the earth may know your name and fear you, as do your people Israel, and that they may know that this house which I have built is called by your name. ³⁴"If your people go out to battle against their enemies, by whatever way you send them, and they pray to you toward this city which you have chosen, and the house which I have built for your name; ³⁵then hear from heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause. ³⁶"If they sin against you (for there is no man who doesn't sin), and you are angry with them and deliver them to the enemy, so that they carry them away captive to a land far off or near; ³⁷yet if they come to their senses in the land where they are carried captive, and turn again, and make supplication to you in the land of their captivity, saying, 'We have sinned, we have done perversely, and have dealt wickedly;' ³⁸if they return to you with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their captivity, where they have been taken captive, and pray toward their land which you gave to their fathers, and the city which you have chosen, and toward the house which I have built for your name; ³⁹then hear from heaven, even from your dwelling place, their prayer and their petitions, and maintain their cause, and forgive your people who have sinned against you. ⁴⁰"Now, my God, let, I beg you, your eyes be open, and let your ears be attentive to the prayer that is made in this place. ⁴¹"Now therefore arise, LORD God, into your resting place, you, and the ark of your strength. Let your priests, LORD God, be clothed with salvation [yeshu'ah], and let your holy ones rejoice in goodness. ⁴²"LORD God, don't turn away the face of your anointed. Remember your loving kindnesses to David your servant."

^{xviii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

7 Now when Solomon had finished praying, fire came down from heaven and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices; and the LORD's glory filled the house. 2 The priests could not enter into the LORD's house, because the LORD's glory filled the LORD's house. 3 All the children of Israel looked on, when the fire came down, and the LORD's glory was on the house. They bowed themselves with their faces to the ground on the pavement, worshiped, and gave thanks to the LORD, saying, "For he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever!" 4 Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before the LORD. 5 King Solomon offered a sacrifice of twenty-two thousand head of cattle and a hundred twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the people dedicated God's house. 6 The priests stood, according to their positions; the Levites also with instruments of music of the LORD, which David the king had made to give thanks to the LORD, when David praised by their ministry, saying "For his loving kindness endures forever." The priests sounded shofars ^{xix} or, trumpets before them; and all Israel stood. 7 Moreover Solomon made the middle of the court that was before the LORD's house holy; for there he offered the burnt offerings and the fat of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar which Solomon had made was not able to receive the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat. 8 So Solomon held the feast at that time for seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great assembly, from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of Egypt. 9 On the eighth day, they held a solemn assembly; for they kept the dedication of the altar seven days, and the feast seven days. 10 On the twenty-third day of the seventh month, he sent the people away to their tents, joyful and glad of heart for the goodness that the LORD had shown to David, to Solomon, and to Israel his people. 11 Thus Solomon finished the LORD's house and the king's house; and he successfully completed all that came into Solomon's heart to make in the LORD's house and in his own house. 12 Then the LORD appeared to Solomon by night, and said to him, "I have heard your prayer, and have chosen this place for myself for a house of sacrifice. 13 "If I shut up the sky so that there is no rain, or if I command the locust to devour the land, or if I send pestilence among my people, 14 if my people who are called by my name will humble themselves, pray, seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, will forgive their sin, and will heal their land. 15 Now my eyes will be open and my ears attentive to prayer that is made in this place. 16 For now I have chosen and made this house holy, that my name may be there forever; and my eyes and my heart will be there perpetually. 17 "As for you, if you will walk before me as David your father walked, and do according to all that I have commanded you, and will keep my statutes and my ordinances, 18 then I will estab-

lish the throne of your kingdom, according as I covenanted with David your father, saying, 'There shall not fail you a man to be ruler in Israel.' 19 But if you turn away and forsake my statutes and my commandments which I have set before you, and go and serve other gods and worship them, 20 then I will pluck them up by the roots out of my land which I have given them; and this house, which I have made holy for my name, I will cast out of my sight, and I will make it a proverb and a byword among all peoples. 21 This house, which is so high, everyone who passes by it will be astonished and say, 'Why has the LORD done this to this land and to this house?' 22 They shall answer, 'Because they abandoned the LORD, the God of their fathers, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, and took other gods, worshiped them, and served them. Therefore he has brought all this evil on them.'

8 At the end of twenty years, in which Solomon had built the LORD's house and his own house, 2 Solomon built the cities which Hiram had given to Solomon, and caused the children of Israel to dwell there. 3 Solomon went to Hamath Zobah, and prevailed against it. 4 He built Tadmor in the wilderness, and all the storage cities, which he built in Hamath. 5 Also he built Beth Horon the upper and Beth Horon the lower, fortified cities with walls, gates, and bars; 6 and Baalath, and all the storage cities that Solomon had, and all the cities for his chariots, the cities for his horsemen, and all that Solomon desired to build for his pleasure in Jerusalem, in Lebanon, and in all the land of his dominion. 7 As for all the people who were left of the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were not of Israel— 8 of their children who were left after them in the land, whom the children of Israel didn't consume—of them Solomon conscripted forced labor to this day. 9 But of the children of Israel, Solomon made no servants for his work, but they were men of war, chief of his captains, and rulers of his chariots and of his horsemen. 10 These were the chief officers of King Solomon, even two-hundred fifty, who ruled over the people. 11 Solomon brought up Pharaoh's daughter out of David's city to the house that he had built for her; for he said, "My wife shall not dwell in the house of David king of Israel, because the places where the LORD's ark has come are holy." 12 Then Solomon offered burnt offerings to the LORD on the LORD's altar which he had built before the porch, 13 even as the duty of every day required, offering according to the commandment of Moses on the Sabbaths, on the new moons, and on the set feasts, three times per year, during the feast of unleavened bread, during the feast of weeks, and during the feast of booths. ^{xx} 14 He appointed, according to the ordinance of David his father, the divisions of the priests to their service, and the Levites to their offices, to praise and to minister before the

^{xix}or, trumpets

^{xx}or, feast of booths (Sukkot)

priests, as the duty of every day required, the doorkeepers also by their divisions at every gate, for David the man of God had so commanded. ¹⁵They didn't depart from the commandment of the king to the priests and Levites concerning any matter or concerning the treasures. ¹⁶Now all the work of Solomon was accomplished from the day of the foundation of the LORD's house until it was finished. So the LORD's house was completed. ¹⁷Then Solomon went to Ezion Geber and to Eloth, on the seashore in the land of Edom. ¹⁸Huram sent him ships and servants who had knowledge of the sea by the hands of his servants; and they came with the servants of Solomon to Ophir, and brought from there four hundred fifty talents ^{xxi} of gold, and brought them to King Solomon.

⁹When the queen of Sheba heard of the fame of Solomon, she came to test Solomon with hard questions at Jerusalem, with a very great caravan, including camels that bore spices, gold in abundance, and precious stones. When she had come to Solomon, she talked with him about all that was in her heart. ²Solomon answered all her questions. There wasn't anything hidden from Solomon which he didn't tell her. ³When the queen of Sheba had seen the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had built, ⁴the food of his table, the seating of his servants, the attendance of his ministers, their clothing, his cup bearers and their clothing, and his ascent by which he went up to the LORD's house, there was no more spirit in her. ^{xxii} ⁵She said to the king, "It was a true report that I heard in my own land of your acts and of your wisdom. ⁶However I didn't believe their words until I came, and my eyes had seen it; and behold half of the greatness of your wisdom wasn't told me. You exceed the fame that I heard! ⁷Happy are your men, and happy are these your servants, who stand continually before you and hear your wisdom. ⁸Blessed be the LORD your God, who delighted in you and set you on his throne to be king for the LORD your God, because your God loved Israel, to establish them forever. Therefore he made you king over them, to do justice and righteousness." ⁹She gave the king one hundred and twenty talents ^{xxiii} of gold, spices in great abundance, and precious stones. There was never before such spice as the queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon. ¹⁰The servants of Huram and the servants of Solomon, who brought gold from Ophir, also brought al gum trees ^{xxiv} and precious stones. ¹¹The king used al gum tree wood to make terraces for the LORD's house and for the king's house, and harps and stringed instruments for the singers. There were none like these seen before in the

land of Judah. ¹²King Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba all her desire, whatever she asked, more than that which she had brought to the king. So she turned and went to her own land, she and her servants. ¹³Now the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred sixty-six talents ^{xxv} of gold, ¹⁴in addition to that which the traders and merchants brought. All the kings of Arabia and the governors of the country brought gold and silver to Solomon. ¹⁵King Solomon made two hundred large shields of beaten gold. Six hundred shekels ^{xxvi} of beaten gold went to one large shield. ¹⁶He made three hundred shields of beaten gold. Three hundred shekels ^{xxvii} of gold went to one shield. The king put them in the House of the Forest of Lebanon. ¹⁷Moreover the king made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with pure gold. ¹⁸There were six steps to the throne, with a footstool of gold, which were fastened to the throne, and armrests on either side by the place of the seat, and two lions standing beside the armrests. ¹⁹Twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other on the six steps. There was nothing like it made in any other kingdom. ²⁰All King Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were of pure gold. Silver was not considered valuable in the days of Solomon. ²¹For the king had ships that went to Tarshish with Huram's servants. Once every three years, the ships of Tarshish came bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks. ²²So King Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom. ²³All the kings of the earth sought the presence of Solomon to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart. ²⁴They each brought tribute: vessels of silver, vessels of gold, clothing, armor, spices, horses, and mules every year. ²⁵Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses and chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen that he stationed in the chariot cities and with the king at Jerusalem. ²⁶He ruled over all the kings from the River even to the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt. ²⁷The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stones, and he made cedars to be as abundant as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland. ²⁸They brought horses for Solomon out of Egypt and out of all lands. ²⁹Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, first and last, aren't they written in the history of Nathan the prophet, and in the prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the visions of Iddo the seer concerning Jeroboam the son of Nebat? ³⁰Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years. ³¹Solomon slept with his fathers, and he was buried in his father David's city; and Rehoboam his son reigned in his place.

^{xxi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 450 talents is about 13.5 metric tons

^{xxii}or, she was breathless.

^{xxiii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 120 talents is about 3.6 metric tons

^{xxiv}possibly Indian sandalwood, which has nice grain and a pleasant scent and is good for woodworking

^{xxv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 666 talents is about 20 metric tons

^{xxvi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels was about 6 kilograms or about 192 Troy ounces.

^{xxvii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 300 shekels was about 3 kilograms or about 96 Troy ounces.

10Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king. ²When Jeroboam the son of Nebat heard of it (for he was in Egypt, where he had fled from the presence of King Solomon), Jeroboam returned out of Egypt. ³They sent and called him; and Jeroboam and all Israel came, and they spoke to Rehoboam, saying, ⁴“Your father made our yoke grievous. Now therefore make the grievous service of your father and his heavy yoke which he put on us, lighter, and we will serve you.” ⁵He said to them, “Come again to me after three days.” So the people departed. ⁶King Rehoboam took counsel with the old men, who had stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, saying, “What counsel do you give me about how to answer these people?” ⁷They spoke to him, saying, “If you are kind to these people, please them, and speak good words to them, then they will be your servants forever.” ⁸But he abandoned the counsel of the old men which they had given him, and took counsel with the young men who had grown up with him, who stood before him. ⁹He said to them, “What counsel do you give, that we may give an answer to these people, who have spoken to me, saying, ‘Make the yoke that your father put on us lighter?’” ¹⁰The young men who had grown up with him spoke to him, saying, “Thus you shall tell the people who spoke to you, saying, ‘Your father made our yoke heavy, but make it lighter on us;’ thus you shall say to them, ‘My little finger is thicker than my father’s waist. ¹¹Now whereas my father burdened you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke. My father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.’” ¹²So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king asked, saying, “Come to me again the third day.” ¹³The king answered them roughly; and King Rehoboam abandoned the counsel of the old men, ¹⁴and spoke to them after the counsel of the young men, saying, “My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add to it. My father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.” ¹⁵So the king didn’t listen to the people; for it was brought about by God, that the LORD might establish his word, which he spoke by Ahijah the Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat. ¹⁶When all Israel saw that the king didn’t listen to them, the people answered the king, saying, “What portion do we have in David? We don’t have an inheritance in the son of Jesse! Every man to your tents, Israel! Now see to your own house, David.” So all Israel departed to their tents. ¹⁷But as for the children of Israel who lived in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them. ¹⁸Then King Rehoboam sent Hadoram, who was over the men subject to forced labor; and the children of Israel stoned him to death with stones. King Rehoboam hurried to get himself up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem. ¹⁹So Israel rebelled against David’s house to this day.

11When Rehoboam had come to Jerusalem, he assem-

bled the house of Judah and Benjamin, one hundred eighty thousand chosen men who were warriors, to fight against Israel, to bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam. ²But the LORD’s word came to Shemaiah the man of God, saying, ³“Speak to Rehoboam the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all Israel in Judah and Benjamin, saying, ⁴‘The LORD says, “You shall not go up, nor fight against your brothers! Every man return to his house; for this thing is of me.”’” So they listened to the LORD’s words, and returned from going against Jeroboam. ⁵Rehoboam lived in Jerusalem, and built cities for defense in Judah. ⁶He built Bethlehem, Etam, Tekoa, ⁷Beth Zur, Soco, Adullam, ⁸Gath, Mareshah, Ziph, ⁹Adoraim, Lachish, Azekah, ¹⁰Zorah, Aijalon, and Hebron, which are fortified cities in Judah and in Benjamin. ¹¹He fortified the strongholds and put captains in them with stores of food, oil and wine. ¹²He put shields and spears in every city, and made them exceedingly strong. Judah and Benjamin belonged to him. ¹³The priests and the Levites who were in all Israel stood with him out of all their territory. ¹⁴For the Levites left their pasture lands and their possessions, and came to Judah and Jerusalem; for Jeroboam and his sons cast them off, that they should not execute the priest’s office to the LORD. ¹⁵He himself appointed priests for the high places, for the male goat and calf idols which he had made. ¹⁶After them, out of all the tribes of Israel, those who set their hearts to seek the LORD, the God of Israel, came to Jerusalem to sacrifice to the LORD, the God of their fathers. ¹⁷So they strengthened the kingdom of Judah and made Rehoboam the son of Solomon strong for three years, for they walked three years in the way of David and Solomon. ¹⁸Rehoboam took a wife for himself, Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the son of David and of Abihail the daughter of Eliab the son of Jesse. ¹⁹She bore him sons: Jeush, Shemariah, and Zaham. ²⁰After her, he took Maacah the granddaughter of Absalom; and she bore him Abijah, Attai, Ziza, and Shelomith. ²¹Rehoboam loved Maacah the granddaughter of Absalom above all his wives and his concubines; for he took eighteen wives and sixty concubines, and became the father of twenty-eight sons and sixty daughters. ²²Rehoboam appointed Abijah the son of Maacah to be chief, the prince among his brothers, for he intended to make him king. ²³He dealt wisely, and dispersed some of his sons throughout all the lands of Judah and Benjamin, to every fortified city. He gave them food in abundance; and he sought many wives for them.

12When the kingdom of Rehoboam was established and he was strong, he abandoned the LORD’s law, and all Israel with him. ²In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, because they had trespassed against the LORD, ³with twelve hundred chariots and sixty thousand horsemen. The people were without number who came with him out of Egypt:

the Lubim, the Sukkiim, and the Ethiopians. ⁴He took the fortified cities which belonged to Judah, and came to Jerusalem. ⁵Now Shemaiah the prophet came to Rehoboam and to the princes of Judah, who were gathered together to Jerusalem because of Shishak, and said to them, "The LORD says, 'You have forsaken me, therefore I have also left you in the hand of Shishak.'" ⁶Then the princes of Israel and the king humbled themselves; and they said, "The LORD is righteous." ⁷When the LORD saw that they humbled themselves, the LORD's word came to Shemaiah, saying, "They have humbled themselves. I will not destroy them, but I will grant them some deliverance, and my wrath won't be poured out on Jerusalem by the hand of Shishak. ⁸Nevertheless they will be his servants, that they may know my service, and the service of the kingdoms of the countries." ⁹So Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem and took away the treasures of the LORD's house and the treasures of the king's house. He took it all away. He also took away the shields of gold which Solomon had made. ¹⁰King Rehoboam made shields of bronze in their place, and committed them to the hands of the captains of the guard, who kept the door of the king's house. ¹¹As often as the king entered into the LORD's house, the guard came and bore them, then brought them back into the guard room. ¹²When he humbled himself, the LORD's wrath turned from him, so as not to destroy him altogether. Moreover, there were good things found in Judah. ¹³So King Rehoboam strengthened himself in Jerusalem and reigned; for Rehoboam was forty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the LORD had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel to put his name there. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonitess. ¹⁴He did that which was evil, because he didn't set his heart to seek the LORD. ¹⁵Now the acts of Rehoboam, first and last, aren't they written in the histories of Shemaiah the prophet and of Iddo the seer, in the genealogies? There were wars between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually. ¹⁶Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried in David's city; and Abijah his son reigned in his place.

13In the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam, Abijah began to reign over Judah. ²He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Micaiah the daughter of Uriel of Gibeah. There was war between Abijah and Jeroboam. ³Abijah joined battle with an army of valiant men of war, even four hundred thousand chosen men; and Jeroboam set the battle in array against him with eight hundred thousand chosen men, who were mighty men of valor. ⁴Abijah stood up on Mount Zemaraim, which is in the hill country of Ephraim, and said, "Hear me, Jeroboam and all Israel: ⁵Ought you not to know that the LORD, the God of Israel, gave the kingdom over Israel to David forever, even to him and to his sons by a covenant

of salt? ⁶Yet Jeroboam the son of Nebat, the servant of Solomon the son of David, rose up, and rebelled against his lord. ⁷Worthless men were gathered to him, wicked fellows who strengthened themselves against Rehoboam the son of Solomon, when Rehoboam was young and tender hearted, and could not withstand them. ⁸"Now you intend to withstand the kingdom of the LORD in the hand of the sons of David. You are a great multitude, and the golden calves which Jeroboam made you for gods are with you. ⁹Haven't you driven out the priests of the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and made priests for yourselves according to the ways of the peoples of other lands? Whoever comes to consecrate himself with a young bull and seven rams may be a priest of those who are no gods. ¹⁰"But as for us, the LORD is our God, and we have not forsaken him. We have priests serving the LORD, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites in their work. ¹¹They burn to the LORD every morning and every evening burnt offerings and sweet incense. They also set the show bread in order on the pure table, and care for the gold lamp stand with its lamps, to burn every evening; for we keep the instruction of the LORD our God, but you have forsaken him. ¹²Behold, God is with us at our head, and his priests with the shofars ^{xxviii} or, trumpetsof alarm to sound an alarm against you. Children of Israel, don't fight against the LORD, the God of your fathers; for you will not prosper." ¹³But Jeroboam caused an ambush to come about behind them; so they were before Judah, and the ambush was behind them. ¹⁴When Judah looked back, behold, the battle was before and behind them; and they cried to the LORD, and the priests sounded with the shofars ^{xxix} . or, trumpets ¹⁵Then the men of Judah gave a shout. As the men of Judah shouted, God struck Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah. ¹⁶The children of Israel fled before Judah, and God delivered them into their hand. ¹⁷Abijah and his people killed them with a great slaughter, so five hundred thousand chosen men of Israel fell down slain. ¹⁸Thus the children of Israel were brought under at that time, and the children of Judah prevailed, because they relied on the LORD, the God of their fathers. ¹⁹Abijah pursued Jeroboam, and took cities from him: Bethel with its villages, Jeshanah with its villages, and Ephron with its villages. ²⁰Jeroboam didn't recover strength again in the days of Abijah. The LORD struck him, and he died. ²¹But Abijah grew mighty and took for himself fourteen wives, and became the father of twenty-two sons and sixteen daughters. ²²The rest of the acts of Abijah, his ways, and his sayings are written in the commentary of the prophet Iddo.

14So Abijah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in David's city; and Asa his son reigned in his place.

^{xxviii}or, trumpets
^{xxix}or, trumpets.

In his days, the land was quiet ten years. ²Asa did that which was good and right in the LORD his God's eyes, ³for he took away the foreign altars and the high places, broke down the pillars, cut down the Asherah poles, ⁴and commanded Judah to seek the LORD, the God of their fathers, and to obey his law and command. ⁵Also he took away out of all the cities of Judah the high places and the sun images; and the kingdom was quiet before him. ⁶He built fortified cities in Judah; for the land was quiet, and he had no war in those years, because the LORD had given him rest. ⁷For he said to Judah, "Let's build these cities and make walls around them, with towers, gates, and bars. The land is yet before us, because we have sought the LORD our God. We have sought him, and he has given us rest on every side." So they built and prospered. ⁸Asa had an army of three hundred thousand out of Judah who bore bucklers and spears, and two hundred eighty thousand out of Benjamin who bore shields and drew bows. All these were mighty men of valor. ⁹Zerah the Ethiopian came out against them with an army of a million troops and three hundred chariots, and he came to Mareshah. ¹⁰Then Asa went out to meet him, and they set the battle in array in the valley of Zephathah at Mareshah. ¹¹Asa cried to the LORD his God, and said, "LORD, there is no one besides you to help, between the mighty and him who has no strength. Help us, LORD our God; for we rely on you, and in your name are we come against this multitude. LORD, you are our God. Don't let man prevail against you." ¹²So the LORD struck the Ethiopians before Asa and before Judah; and the Ethiopians fled. ¹³Asa and the people who were with him pursued them to Gerar. So many of the Ethiopians fell that they could not recover themselves, for they were destroyed before the LORD and before his army. Judah's army carried away very much booty. ¹⁴They struck all the cities around Gerar, for the fear of the LORD came on them. They plundered all the cities, for there was much plunder in them. ¹⁵They also struck the tents of those who had livestock, and carried away sheep and camels in abundance, then returned to Jerusalem.

15The Spirit of God came on Azariah the son of Oded. ²He went out to meet Asa, and said to him, "Hear me, Asa, and all Judah and Benjamin! The LORD is with you while you are with him; and if you seek him, he will be found by you; but if you forsake him, he will forsake you. ³Now for a long time Israel was without the true God, without a teaching priest, and without law. ⁴But when in their distress they turned to the LORD, the God of Israel, and sought him, he was found by them. ⁵In those times there was no peace to him who went out, nor to him who came in; but great troubles were on all the inhabitants of the lands. ⁶They were broken in pieces, nation against nation, and city against city; for God troubled them with all adversity.

⁷But you be strong! Don't let your hands be slack, for your work will be rewarded." ⁸When Asa heard these words and the prophecy of Oded the prophet, he took courage, and put away the abominations out of all the land of Judah and Benjamin, and out of the cities which he had taken from the hill country of Ephraim; and he renewed the LORD's altar that was before the LORD's porch. ⁹He gathered all Judah and Benjamin, and those who lived with them out of Ephraim, Manasseh, and Simeon; for they came to him out of Israel in abundance when they saw that the LORD his God was with him. ¹⁰So they gathered themselves together at Jerusalem in the third month, in the fifteenth year of Asa's reign. ¹¹They sacrificed to the LORD in that day, of the plunder which they had brought, seven hundred head of cattle and seven thousand sheep. ¹²They entered into the covenant to seek the LORD, the God of their fathers, with all their heart and with all their soul; ¹³and that whoever would not seek the LORD, the God of Israel, should be put to death, whether small or great, whether man or woman. ¹⁴They swore to the LORD with a loud voice, with shouting, with shofars ^{xxx}, or, trumpets and with cornets. ¹⁵All Judah rejoiced at the oath, for they had sworn with all their heart and sought him with their whole desire; and he was found by them. Then the LORD gave them rest all around. ¹⁶Also Maacah, the mother of Asa the king, he removed from being queen mother, because she had made an abominable image for an Asherah; so Asa cut down her image, ground it into dust, and burned it at the brook Kidron. ¹⁷But the high places were not taken away out of Israel; nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect all his days. ¹⁸He brought the things that his father had dedicated and that he himself had dedicated, silver, gold, and vessels into God's house. ¹⁹There was no more war to the thirty-fifth year of Asa's reign.

16In the thirty-sixth year of Asa's reign, Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not allow anyone to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah. ²Then Asa brought out silver and gold out of the treasures of the LORD's house and of the king's house, and sent to Ben Hadad king of Syria, who lived at Damascus, saying, ³"Let there be a treaty between me and you, as there was between my father and your father. Behold, I have sent you silver and gold. Go, break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me." ⁴Ben Hadad listened to King Asa, and sent the captains of his armies against the cities of Israel; and they struck Ijon, Dan, Abel Maim, and all the storage cities of Naphtali. ⁵When Baasha heard of it, he stopped building Ramah, and let his work cease. ⁶Then Asa the king took all Judah, and they carried away the stones and timber of Ramah, with which Baasha had built; and he built Geba and Mizpah with them. ⁷At that time Hanani the seer came to Asa

^{xxx}or, trumpets,

king of Judah, and said to him, "Because you have relied on the king of Syria, and have not relied on the LORD your God, therefore the army of the king of Syria has escaped out of your hand. ⁸Weren't the Ethiopians and the Lubim a huge army, with chariots and exceedingly many horsemen? Yet, because you relied on the LORD, he delivered them into your hand. ⁹For the LORD's eyes run back and forth throughout the whole earth, to show himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him. You have done foolishly in this; for from now on you will have wars." ¹⁰Then Asa was angry with the seer, and put him in the prison; for he was in a rage with him because of this thing. Asa oppressed some of the people at the same time. ¹¹Behold, the acts of Asa, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel. ¹²In the thirty-ninth year of his reign, Asa was diseased in his feet. His disease was exceedingly great; yet in his disease he didn't seek the LORD, but just the physicians. ¹³Asa slept with his fathers, and died in the forty-first year of his reign. ¹⁴They buried him in his own tomb, which he had dug out for himself in David's city, and laid him in the bed which was filled with sweet odors and various kinds of spices prepared by the perfumers' art; and they made a very great fire for him.

¹⁷Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his place, and strengthened himself against Israel. ²He placed forces in all the fortified cities of Judah, and set garrisons in the land of Judah and in the cities of Ephraim, which Asa his father had taken. ³The LORD was with Jehoshaphat, because he walked in the first ways of his father David, and didn't seek the Baals, ⁴but sought the God of his father, and walked in his commandments, and not in the ways of Israel. ⁵Therefore the LORD established the kingdom in his hand. All Judah brought tribute to Jehoshaphat, and he had riches and honor in abundance. ⁶His heart was lifted up in the ways of the LORD. Furthermore, he took away the high places and the Asherah poles out of Judah. ⁷Also in the third year of his reign he sent his princes, even Ben Hail, Obadiah, Zechariah, Nethanel, and Micaiah, to teach in the cities of Judah; ⁸and with them Levites, even Shemaiah, Nethaniah, Zebadiah, Asahel, Shemiramoth, Jehonathan, Adonijah, Tobijah, and Tobadonijah, the Levites; and with them Elishama and Jehoram, the priests. ⁹They taught in Judah, having the book of the LORD's law with them. They went about throughout all the cities of Judah and taught among the people. ¹⁰The fear of the LORD fell on all the kingdoms of the lands that were around Judah, so that they made no war against Jehoshaphat. ¹¹Some of the Philistines brought Jehoshaphat presents and silver for tribute. The Arabians also brought him flocks: seven thousand seven hundred rams and seven thousand seven hundred male goats. ¹²Jehoshaphat grew great exceedingly; and he built fortresses and store cities in Judah.

¹³He had many works in the cities of Judah; and men of war, mighty men of valor, in Jerusalem. ¹⁴This was the numbering of them according to their fathers' houses: From Judah, the captains of thousands: Adnah the captain, and with him three hundred thousand mighty men of valor; ¹⁵and next to him Jehohanan the captain, and with him two hundred eighty thousand; ¹⁶and next to him Amasiah the son of Zichri, who willingly offered himself to the LORD, and with him two hundred thousand mighty men of valor. ¹⁷From Benjamin: Eliada, a mighty man of valor, and with him two hundred thousand armed with bow and shield; ¹⁸and next to him Jehozabad, and with him one hundred eighty thousand ready and prepared for war. ¹⁹These were those who waited on the king, in addition to those whom the king put in the fortified cities throughout all Judah.

¹⁸Now Jehoshaphat had riches and honor in abundance; and he allied himself with Ahab. ²After some years, he went down to Ahab to Samaria. Ahab killed sheep and cattle for him in abundance, and for the people who were with him, and moved him to go up with him to Ramoth Gilead. ³Ahab king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat king of Judah, "Will you go with me to Ramoth Gilead?" He answered him, "I am as you are, and my people as your people. We will be with you in the war." ⁴Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "Please inquire first for the LORD's word." ⁵Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, four hundred men, and said to them, "Shall we go to Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall I forbear?" They said, "Go up, for God will deliver it into the hand of the king." ⁶But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there here a prophet of the LORD besides, that we may inquire of him?" ⁷The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of the LORD; but I hate him, for he never prophesies good concerning me, but always evil. He is Micaiah the son of Imla." Jehoshaphat said, "Don't let the king say so." ⁸Then the king of Israel called an officer, and said, "Get Micaiah the son of Imla quickly." ⁹Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah each sat on his throne, arrayed in their robes, and they were sitting in an open place at the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets were prophesying before them. ¹⁰Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made himself horns of iron and said, "The LORD says, 'With these you shall push the Syrians, until they are consumed.'" ¹¹All the prophets prophesied so, saying, "Go up to Ramoth Gilead, and prosper; for the LORD will deliver it into the hand of the king." ¹²The messenger who went to call Micaiah spoke to him, saying, "Behold, the words of the prophets declare good to the king with one mouth. Let your word therefore, please be like one of theirs, and speak good." ¹³Micaiah said, "As the LORD lives, I will say what my God says." ¹⁴When he had come to the king, the king said to him, "Micaiah, shall

we go to Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall I forbear?" He said, "Go up, and prosper. They shall be delivered into your hand." ¹⁵The king said to him, "How many times shall I adjure you that you speak to me nothing but the truth in the LORD's name?" ¹⁶He said, "I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. The LORD said, 'These have no master. Let them each return to his house in peace.'" ¹⁷The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Didn't I tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?" ¹⁸Micaiah said, "Therefore hear the LORD's word: I saw the LORD sitting on his throne, and all the army of heaven standing on his right hand and on his left. ¹⁹The LORD said, 'Who will entice Ahab king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth Gilead?' One spoke saying in this way, and another saying in that way. ²⁰A spirit came out, stood before the LORD, and said, 'I will entice him.' "The LORD said to him, 'How?' ²¹He said, 'I will go, and will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.' "He said, 'You will entice him, and will prevail also. Go and do so.' ²²"Now therefore, behold, the LORD has put a lying spirit in the mouth of these your prophets; and the LORD has spoken evil concerning you." ²³Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and struck Micaiah on the cheek, and said, "Which way did the LORD's Spirit go from me to speak to you?" ²⁴Micaiah said, "Behold, you shall see on that day, when you go into an inner room to hide yourself." ²⁵The king of Israel said, "Take Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son; ²⁶and say, 'The king says, "Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I return in peace."' " ²⁷Micaiah said, "If you return at all in peace, the LORD has not spoken by me." He said, "Listen, you people, all of you!" ²⁸So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth Gilead. ²⁹The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will disguise myself, and go into the battle; but you put on your robes." So the king of Israel disguised himself; and they went into the battle. ³⁰Now the king of Syria had commanded the captains of his chariots, saying, "Don't fight with small nor great, except only with the king of Israel." ³¹When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, "It is the king of Israel!" Therefore they turned around to fight against him. But Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him; and God moved them to depart from him. ³²When the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him. ³³A certain man drew his bow at random, and struck the king of Israel between the joints of the armor. Therefore he said to the driver of the chariot, "Turn around and carry me out of the battle, for I am severely wounded." ³⁴The battle increased that day. However, the king of Israel propped himself up in his chariot against the Syrians until the evening; and at

about sunset, he died.

19Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned to his house in peace to Jerusalem. ²Jehu the son of Hanani the seer went out to meet him, and said to King Jehoshaphat, "Should you help the wicked, and love those who hate the LORD? Because of this, wrath is on you from before the LORD. ³Nevertheless there are good things found in you, in that you have put away the Asheroth out of the land, and have set your heart to seek God." ⁴Jehoshaphat lived at Jerusalem; and he went out again among the people from Beersheba to the hill country of Ephraim, and brought them back to the LORD, the God of their fathers. ⁵He set judges in the land throughout all the fortified cities of Judah, city by city, ⁶and said to the judges, "Consider what you do, for you don't judge for man, but for the LORD; and he is with you in the judgment. ⁷Now therefore let the fear of the LORD be on you. Take heed and do it; for there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons, nor taking of bribes." ⁸Moreover in Jerusalem Jehoshaphat appointed certain Levites, priests, and heads of the fathers' households of Israel to give judgment for the LORD and for controversies. They returned to Jerusalem. ⁹He commanded them, saying, "You shall do this in the fear of the LORD, faithfully, and with a perfect heart. ¹⁰Whenever any controversy comes to you from your brothers who dwell in their cities, between blood and blood, between law and commandment, statutes and ordinances, you must warn them, that they not be guilty toward the LORD, and so wrath come on you and on your brothers. Do this, and you will not be guilty. ¹¹Behold, Amariah the chief priest is over you in all matters of the LORD; and Zedabiah the son of Ishmael, the ruler of the house of Judah, in all the king's matters. Also the Levites shall be officers before you. Deal courageously, and may the LORD be with the good."

20After this, the children of Moab, the children of Ammon, and with them some of the Ammonites, came against Jehoshaphat to battle. ²Then some came who told Jehoshaphat, saying, "A great multitude is coming against you from beyond the sea from Syria. Behold, they are in Hazazon Tamar" (that is, En Gedi). ³Jehoshaphat was alarmed, and set himself to seek to the LORD. He proclaimed a fast throughout all Judah. ⁴Judah gathered themselves together to seek help from the LORD. They came out of all the cities of Judah to seek the LORD. ⁵Jehoshaphat stood in the assembly of Judah and Jerusalem, in the LORD's house, before the new court; ⁶and he said, "LORD, the God of our fathers, aren't you God in heaven? Aren't you ruler over all the kingdoms of the nations? Power and might are in your hand, so that no one is able to withstand you. ⁷Didn't you, our God, drive out the inhabitants of this land before your people Israel, and give

it to the offspring ^{xxxix} of Abraham your friend forever? ⁸They lived in it, and have built you a sanctuary in it for your name, saying, ⁹'If evil comes on us—the sword, judgment, pestilence, or famine—we will stand before this house, and before you (for your name is in this house), and cry to you in our affliction, and you will hear and save.' ¹⁰Now, behold, the children of Ammon and Moab and Mount Seir, whom you would not let Israel invade when they came out of the land of Egypt, but they turned away from them, and didn't destroy them; ¹¹behold, how they reward us, to come to cast us out of your possession, which you have given us to inherit. ¹²Our God, will you not judge them? For we have no might against this great company that comes against us. We don't know what to do, but our eyes are on you." ¹³All Judah stood before the LORD, with their little ones, their wives, and their children. ¹⁴Then the LORD's Spirit came on Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, the son of Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of Mattaniah, the Levite, of the sons of Asaph, in the middle of the assembly; ¹⁵and he said, "Listen, all Judah, and you inhabitants of Jerusalem, and you, King Jehoshaphat. The LORD says to you, 'Don't be afraid, and don't be dismayed because of this great multitude; for the battle is not yours, but God's.' ¹⁶Tomorrow, go down against them. Behold, they are coming up by the ascent of Ziz. You will find them at the end of the valley, before the wilderness of Jeruel. ¹⁷You will not need to fight this battle. Set yourselves, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD with you, O Judah and Jerusalem. Don't be afraid, nor be dismayed. Go out against them tomorrow, for the LORD is with you.'" ¹⁸Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his face to the ground; and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem fell down before the LORD, worshiping the LORD. ¹⁹The Levites, of the children of the Kohathites and of the children of the Korahites, stood up to praise the LORD, the God of Israel, with an exceedingly loud voice. ²⁰They rose early in the morning and went out into the wilderness of Tekoa. As they went out, Jehoshaphat stood and said, "Listen to me, Judah and you inhabitants of Jerusalem! Believe in the LORD your God, so you will be established! Believe his prophets, so you will prosper." ²¹When he had taken counsel with the people, he appointed those who were to sing to the LORD and give praise in holy array as they go out before the army, and say, "Give thanks to the LORD, for his loving kindness endures forever." ²²When they began to sing and to praise, the LORD set ambushers against the children of Ammon, Moab, and Mount Seir, who had come against Judah; and they were struck. ²³For the children of Ammon and Moab stood up against the inhabitants of Mount Seir to utterly kill and destroy them. When they had finished the inhabitants of Seir, everyone helped to destroy each other. ²⁴When Judah came to the place overlooking

the wilderness, they looked at the multitude; and behold, they were dead bodies fallen to the earth, and there were none who escaped. ²⁵When Jehoshaphat and his people came to take their plunder, they found among them in abundance both riches and dead bodies with precious jewels, which they stripped off for themselves, more than they could carry away. They took plunder for three days, it was so much. ²⁶On the fourth day, they assembled themselves in Beracah ^{xxxii} Valley, for there they blessed the LORD. Therefore the name of that place was called "Beracah Valley" to this day. ²⁷Then they returned, every man of Judah and Jerusalem, with Jehoshaphat in front of them, to go again to Jerusalem with joy; for the LORD had made them to rejoice over their enemies. ²⁸They came to Jerusalem with stringed instruments, harps, and shofars ^{xxxiii} or, trumpets to the LORD's house. ²⁹The fear of God was on all the kingdoms of the countries when they heard that the LORD fought against the enemies of Israel. ³⁰So the realm of Jehoshaphat was quiet, for his God gave him rest all around. ³¹So Jehoshaphat reigned over Judah. He was thirty-five years old when he began to reign. He reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi. ³²He walked in the way of Asa his father, and didn't turn away from it, doing that which was right in the LORD's eyes. ³³However the high places were not taken away, and the people had still not set their hearts on the God of their fathers. ³⁴Now the rest of the acts of Jehoshaphat, first and last, behold, they are written in the history of Jehu the son of Hanani, which is included in the book of the kings of Israel. ³⁵After this, Jehoshaphat king of Judah joined himself with Ahaziah king of Israel. The same did very wickedly. ³⁶He joined himself with him to make ships to go to Tarshish. They made the ships in Ezion Geber. ³⁷Then Eliezer the son of Dodavahu of Mareshah prophesied against Jehoshaphat, saying, "Because you have joined yourself with Ahaziah, the LORD has destroyed your works." The ships were wrecked, so that they were not able to go to Tarshish.

21 Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David's city; and Jehoram his son reigned in his place. ²He had brothers, the sons of Jehoshaphat: Azariah, Jehiel, Zechariah, Azariah, Michael, and Shephatiah. All these were the sons of Jehoshaphat king of Israel. ³Their father gave them great gifts of silver, of gold, and of precious things, with fortified cities in Judah; but he gave the kingdom to Jehoram, because he was the first-born. ⁴Now when Jehoram had risen up over the kingdom of his father, and had strengthened himself, he killed all his brothers with the sword, and also some of the princes of Israel. ⁵Jehoram was thirty-two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem. ⁶He

^{xxxii}"Beracah" means "blessing".
^{xxxiii}or, trumpets

^{xxxix}or, seed

walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as did Ahab's house, for he had Ahab's daughter as his wife. He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight. ⁷However the LORD would not destroy David's house, because of the covenant that he had made with David, and as he promised to give a lamp to him and to his children always. ⁸In his days Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah, and made a king over themselves. ⁹Then Jehoram went there with his captains and all his chariots with him. He rose up by night and struck the Edomites who surrounded him, along with the captains of the chariots. ¹⁰So Edom has been in revolt from under the hand of Judah to this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time from under his hand, because he had forsaken the LORD, the God of his fathers. ¹¹Moreover he made high places in the mountains of Judah, and made the inhabitants of Jerusalem play the prostitute, and led Judah astray. ¹²A letter came to him from Elijah the prophet, saying, "the LORD, the God of David your father, says, 'Because you have not walked in the ways of Jehoshaphat your father, nor in the ways of Asa king of Judah, ¹³but have walked in the way of the kings of Israel, and have made Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem to play the prostitute like Ahab's house did, and also have slain your brothers of your father's house, who were better than yourself, ¹⁴behold, the LORD will strike your people with a great plague, including your children, your wives, and all your possessions; ¹⁵and you will have great sickness with a disease of your bowels, until your bowels fall out by reason of the sickness, day by day.'" ¹⁶The LORD stirred up against Jehoram the spirit of the Philistines and of the Arabians who are beside the Ethiopians; ¹⁷and they came up against Judah, broke into it, and carried away all the possessions that were found in the king's house, including his sons and his wives, so that there was no son left to him except Jehoahaz, the youngest of his sons. ¹⁸After all this the LORD struck him in his bowels with an incurable disease. ¹⁹In process of time, at the end of two years, his bowels fell out by reason of his sickness, and he died of severe diseases. His people made no burning for him, like the burning of his fathers. ²⁰He was thirty-two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem eight years. He departed with no one's regret. They buried him in David's city, but not in the tombs of the kings.

22The inhabitants of Jerusalem made Ahaziah his youngest son king in his place, because the band of men who came with the Arabians to the camp had slain all the oldest. So Ahaziah the son of Jehoram king of Judah reigned. ²Ahaziah was forty-two years old when he began to reign, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Athaliah the daughter of Omri. ³He also walked in the ways of Ahab's house, because his mother was his counselor in acting wickedly. ⁴He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, as did Ahab's house, for they

were his counselors after the death of his father, to his destruction. ⁵He also followed their counsel, and went with Jehoram the son of Ahab king of Israel to war against Hazael king of Syria at Ramoth Gilead; and the Syrians wounded Joram. ⁶He returned to be healed in Jezreel of the wounds which they had given him at Ramah, when he fought against Hazael king of Syria. Azariah the son of Jehoram, king of Judah, went down to see Jehoram the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick. ⁷Now the destruction of Ahaziah was of God, in that he went to Joram; for when he had come, he went out with Jehoram against Jehu the son of Nimshi, whom the LORD had anointed to cut off Ahab's house. ⁸When Jehu was executing judgment on Ahab's house, he found the princes of Judah and the sons of the brothers of Ahaziah serving Ahaziah, and killed them. ⁹He sought Ahaziah, and they caught him (now he was hiding in Samaria), and they brought him to Jehu and killed him; and they buried him, for they said, "He is the son of Jehoshaphat, who sought the LORD with all his heart." The house of Ahaziah had no power to hold the kingdom. ¹⁰Now when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the royal offspring of the house of Judah. ¹¹But Jehoshabeath, the king's daughter, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stealthily rescued him from among the king's sons who were slain, and put him and his nurse in the bedroom. So Jehoshabeath, the daughter of King Jehoram, the wife of Jehoiada the priest (for she was the sister of Ahaziah), hid him from Athaliah, so that she didn't kill him. ¹²He was with them hidden in God's house six years while Athaliah reigned over the land.

23In the seventh year, Jehoiada strengthened himself, and took the captains of hundreds—Azariah the son of Jeroham, Ishmael the son of Jehohanan, Azariah the son of Obed, Maaseiah the son of Adaiah, and Elishaphat the son of Zichri—into a covenant with him. ²They went around in Judah and gathered the Levites out of all the cities of Judah, and the heads of fathers' households of Israel, and they came to Jerusalem. ³All the assembly made a covenant with the king in God's house. Jehoiada ^{xxxiv}said to them, "Behold, the king's son must reign, as the LORD has spoken concerning the sons of David. ⁴This is the thing that you must do: a third part of you, who come in on the Sabbath, of the priests and of the Levites, shall be gatekeepers of the thresholds. ⁵A third part shall be at the king's house; and a third part at the gate of the foundation. All the people will be in the courts of the LORD's house. ⁶But let no one come into the LORD's house except the priests and those who minister of the Levites. They shall come in, for they are holy, but all the people shall follow the LORD's instructions. ⁷The Levites shall surround the king, every man with his weapons in his hand. Whoever

^{xxxiv}Hebrew

comes into the house, let him be slain. Be with the king when he comes in and when he goes out.”⁸ So the Levites and all Judah did according to all that Jehoiada the priest commanded. They each took his men, those who were to come in on the Sabbath, with those who were to go out on the Sabbath, for Jehoiada the priest didn’t dismiss the shift.⁹ Jehoiada the priest delivered to the captains of hundreds the spears, bucklers, and shields that had been king David’s, which were in God’s house.¹⁰ He set all the people, every man with his weapon in his hand, from the right side of the house to the left side of the house, near the altar and the house, around the king.¹¹ Then they brought out the king’s son, put the crown on him, gave him the covenant, and made him king. Jehoiada and his sons anointed him, and they said, “Long live the king!”¹² When Athaliah heard the noise of the people running and praising the king, she came to the people into the LORD’s house.¹³ Then she looked, and behold, the king stood by his pillar at the entrance, with the captains and the trumpeters by the king. All the people of the land rejoiced and blew shofars ^{xxxv} or, trumpets. The singers also played musical instruments, and led the singing of praise. Then Athaliah tore her clothes, and said, “Treason! treason!”¹⁴ Jehoiada the priest brought out the captains of hundreds who were set over the army, and said to them, “Bring her out between the ranks; and whoever follows her, let him be slain with the sword.” For the priest said, “Don’t kill her in the LORD’s house.”¹⁵ So they made way for her. She went to the entrance of the horse gate to the king’s house; and they killed her there.¹⁶ Jehoiada made a covenant between himself, all the people, and the king, that they should be the LORD’s people.¹⁷ All the people went to the house of Baal, broke it down, broke his altars and his images in pieces, and killed Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars.¹⁸ Jehoiada appointed the officers of the LORD’s house under the hand of the Levitical priests, whom David had distributed in the LORD’s house, to offer the burnt offerings of the LORD, as it is written in the Torah of Moses, with rejoicing and with singing, as David had ordered.¹⁹ He set the gatekeepers at the gates of the LORD’s house, that no one who was unclean in anything should enter in.²⁰ He took the captains of hundreds, the nobles, the governors of the people, and all the people of the land, and brought the king down from the LORD’s house. They came through the upper gate to the king’s house, and set the king on the throne of the kingdom.²¹ So all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet. They had slain Athaliah with the sword.

24 Joash was seven years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Zibiah, of Beersheba.² Joash did that which was right in the LORD’s eyes all the days of Jehoiada

the priest.³ Jehoiada took for him two wives, and he became the father of sons and daughters.⁴ After this, Joash intended to restore the LORD’s house.⁵ He gathered together the priests and the Levites, and said to them, “Go out to the cities of Judah, and gather money to repair the house of your God from all Israel from year to year. See that you expedite this matter.” However the Levites didn’t do it right away.⁶ The king called for Jehoiada the chief, and said to him, “Why haven’t you required of the Levites to bring in the tax of Moses the servant of the LORD, and of the assembly of Israel, out of Judah and out of Jerusalem, for the Tent of the Testimony?”⁷ For the sons of Athaliah, that wicked woman, had broken up God’s house; and they also gave all the dedicated things of the LORD’s house to the Baals.⁸ So the king commanded, and they made a chest, and set it outside at the gate of the LORD’s house.⁹ They made a proclamation through Judah and Jerusalem, to bring in for the LORD the tax that Moses the servant of God laid on Israel in the wilderness.¹⁰ All the princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest, until they had filled it.¹¹ Whenever the chest was brought to the king’s officers by the hand of the Levites, and when they saw that there was much money, the king’s scribe and the chief priest’s officer came and emptied the chest, and took it, and carried it to its place again. Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in abundance.¹² The king and Jehoiada gave it to those who did the work of the service of the LORD’s house. They hired masons and carpenters to restore the LORD’s house, and also those who worked iron and bronze to repair the LORD’s house.¹³ So the workmen worked, and the work of repairing went forward in their hands. They set up God’s house as it was designed, and strengthened it.¹⁴ When they had finished, they brought the rest of the money before the king and Jehoiada, from which were made vessels for the LORD’s house, even vessels with which to minister and to offer, including spoons and vessels of gold and silver. They offered burnt offerings in the LORD’s house continually all the days of Jehoiada.¹⁵ But Jehoiada grew old and was full of days, and he died. He was one hundred thirty years old when he died.¹⁶ They buried him in David’s city among the kings, because he had done good in Israel, and toward God and his house.¹⁷ Now after the death of Jehoiada, the princes of Judah came and bowed down to the king. Then the king listened to them.¹⁸ They abandoned the house of the LORD, the God of their fathers, and served the Asherah poles and the idols, so wrath came on Judah and Jerusalem for this their guiltiness.¹⁹ Yet he sent prophets to them to bring them again to the LORD, and they testified against them; but they would not listen.²⁰ The Spirit of God came on Zechariah the son of Jehoiada the priest; and he stood above the people, and said to them, “God says, ‘Why do you disobey the LORD’s commandments, so that you can’t prosper? Be-

^{xxxv} or, trumpets.

cause you have forsaken the LORD, he has also forsaken you.”²¹ They conspired against him, and stoned him with stones at the commandment of the king in the court of the LORD’s house. ²²Thus Joash the king didn’t remember the kindness which Jehoiada his father had done to him, but killed his son. When he died, he said, “May the LORD look at it, and repay it.” ²³At the end of the year, the army of the Syrians came up against him. They came to Judah and Jerusalem, and destroyed all the princes of the people from among the people, and sent all their plunder to the king of Damascus. ²⁴For the army of the Syrians came with a small company of men; and the LORD delivered a very great army into their hand, because they had forsaken the LORD, the God of their fathers. So they executed judgment on Joash. ²⁵When they had departed from him (for they left him seriously wounded), his own servants conspired against him for the blood of the sons of Jehoiada the priest, and killed him on his bed, and he died. They buried him in David’s city, but they didn’t bury him in the tombs of the kings. ²⁶These are those who conspired against him: Zabad the son of Shimeath the Ammonitess and Jehozabad the son of Shimrith the Moabitess. ²⁷Now concerning his sons, the greatness of the burdens laid on him, and the rebuilding of God’s house, behold, they are written in the commentary of the book of the kings. Amaziah his son reigned in his place.

25Amaziah was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Jehoaddan, of Jerusalem. ²He did that which was right in the LORD’s eyes, but not with a perfect heart. ³Now when the kingdom was established to him, he killed his servants who had killed his father the king. ⁴But he didn’t put their children to death, but did according to that which is written in the Torah in the book of Moses, as the LORD commanded, saying, “The fathers shall not die for the children, neither shall the children die for the fathers; but every man shall die for his own sin.” ⁵Moreover Amaziah gathered Judah together and ordered them according to their fathers’ houses, under captains of thousands and captains of hundreds, even all Judah and Benjamin. He counted them from twenty years old and upward, and found that there were three hundred thousand chosen men, able to go out to war, who could handle spear and shield. ⁶He also hired one hundred thousand mighty men of valor out of Israel for one hundred talents^{xxxvi} of silver. ⁷A man of God came to him, saying, “O king, don’t let the army of Israel go with you, for the LORD is not with Israel, with all the children of Ephraim. ⁸But if you will go, take action, and be strong for the battle. God will overthrow you before the enemy; for God has power to help, and to overthrow.” ⁹Amaziah said to the man of

God, “But what shall we do for the hundred talents^{xxxvii} which I have given to the army of Israel?” The man of God answered, “The LORD is able to give you much more than this.” ¹⁰Then Amaziah separated them, the army that had come to him out of Ephraim, to go home again. Therefore their anger was greatly kindled against Judah, and they returned home in fierce anger. ¹¹Amaziah took courage, and led his people out and went to the Valley of Salt, and struck ten thousand of the children of Seir. ¹²The children of Judah carried away ten thousand alive, and brought them to the top of the rock, and threw them down from the top of the rock, so that they all were broken in pieces. ¹³But the men of the army whom Amaziah sent back, that they should not go with him to battle, fell on the cities of Judah from Samaria even to Beth Horon, and struck of them three thousand, and took much plunder. ¹⁴Now after Amaziah had come from the slaughter of the Edomites, he brought the gods of the children of Seir, and set them up to be his gods, and bowed down himself before them and burned incense to them. ¹⁵Therefore the LORD’s anger burned against Amaziah, and he sent to him a prophet who said to him, “Why have you sought after the gods of the people, which have not delivered their own people out of your hand?” ¹⁶As he talked with him, the king said to him, “Have we made you one of the king’s counselors? Stop! Why should you be struck down?” Then the prophet stopped, and said, “I know that God has determined to destroy you, because you have done this and have not listened to my counsel.” ¹⁷Then Amaziah king of Judah consulted his advisers, and sent to Joash, the son of Jehoahaz, the son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, “Come! Let’s look one another in the face.” ¹⁸Joash king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, “The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, ‘Give your daughter to my son as his wife. Then a wild animal that was in Lebanon passed by and trampled down the thistle. ¹⁹You say to yourself that you have struck Edom; and your heart lifts you up to boast. Now stay at home. Why should you meddle with trouble, that you should fall, even you and Judah with you?’” ²⁰But Amaziah would not listen; for it was of God, that he might deliver them into the hand of their enemies, because they had sought after the gods of Edom. ²¹So Joash king of Israel went up, and he and Amaziah king of Judah looked one another in the face at Beth Shemesh, which belongs to Judah. ²²Judah was defeated by Israel; so every man fled to his tent. ²³Joash king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash the son of Jehoahaz, at Beth Shemesh and brought him to Jerusalem, and broke down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate, four hundred cubits.^{xxxviii} ²⁴He took all the gold and silver, and all the ves-

^{xxxvi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{xxxvii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{xxxviii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters, so 400

sels that were found in God's house with Obed-Edom, and the treasures of the king's house, and the hostages, and returned to Samaria. ²⁵Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, lived for fifteen years after the death of Joash, son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel. ²⁶Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, first and last, behold, aren't they written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel? ²⁷Now from the time that Amaziah turned away from following the LORD, they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem. He fled to Lachish, but they sent after him to Lachish and killed him there. ²⁸They brought him on horses and buried him with his fathers in the City of Judah.

26All the people of Judah took Uzziah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king in the place of his father Amaziah. ²He built Eloth and restored it to Judah. After that the king slept with his fathers. ³Uzziah was sixteen years old when he began to reign; and he reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jechiliah, of Jerusalem. ⁴He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, according to all that his father Amaziah had done. ⁵He set himself to seek God in the days of Zechariah, who had understanding in the vision of God; and as long as he sought the LORD, God made him prosper. ⁶He went out and fought against the Philistines, and broke down the wall of Gath, the wall of Jabneh, and the wall of Ashdod; and he built cities in the country of Ashdod, and among the Philistines. ⁷God helped him against the Philistines, and against the Arabians who lived in Gur Baal, and the Meunim. ⁸The Ammonites gave tribute to Uzziah. His name spread abroad even to the entrance of Egypt, for he grew exceedingly strong. ⁹Moreover Uzziah built towers in Jerusalem at the corner gate, at the valley gate, and at the turning of the wall, and fortified them. ¹⁰He built towers in the wilderness, and dug out many cisterns, for he had much livestock, both in the lowlands and in the plains. He had farmers and vineyard keepers in the mountains and in the fruitful fields, for he loved farming. ¹¹Moreover Uzziah had an army of fighting men who went out to war by bands, according to the number of their reckoning made by Jeiel the scribe and Maaseiah the officer, under the hand of Hananiah, one of the king's captains. ¹²The whole number of the heads of fathers' households, even the mighty men of valor, was two thousand six hundred. ¹³Under their hand was an army, three hundred seven thousand five hundred, who made war with mighty power, to help the king against the enemy. ¹⁴Uzziah prepared for them, even for all the army, shields, spears, helmets, coats of mail, bows, and stones for slinging. ¹⁵In Jerusalem, he made devices, invented by skillful men, to be on the towers and on the battlements, with which to shoot arrows and great stones. His name spread far abroad, because he was marvelously helped until he was strong. ¹⁶But when he was strong,

his heart was lifted up, so that he did corruptly and he trespassed against the LORD his God, for he went into the LORD's temple to burn incense on the altar of incense. ¹⁷Azariah the priest went in after him, and with him eighty priests of the LORD, who were valiant men. ¹⁸They resisted Uzziah the king, and said to him, "It isn't for you, Uzziah, to burn incense to the LORD, but for the priests the sons of Aaron, who are consecrated to burn incense. Go out of the sanctuary, for you have trespassed. It will not be for your honor from the LORD God." ¹⁹Then Uzziah was angry. He had a censer in his hand to burn incense, and while he was angry with the priests, the leprosy broke out on his forehead before the priests in the LORD's house, beside the altar of incense. ²⁰Azariah the chief priest and all the priests looked at him, and behold, he was leprous in his forehead; and they thrust him out quickly from there. Indeed, he himself also hurried to go out, because the LORD had struck him. ²¹Uzziah the king was a leper to the day of his death, and lived in a separate house, being a leper; for he was cut off from the LORD's house. Jotham his son was over the king's house, judging the people of the land. ²²Now the rest of the acts of Uzziah, first and last, Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, wrote. ²³So Uzziah slept with his fathers; and they buried him with his fathers in the field of burial which belonged to the kings, for they said, "He is a leper." Jotham his son reigned in his place.

27Jotham was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jerushah the daughter of Zadok. ²He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, according to all that his father Uzziah had done. However he didn't enter into the LORD's temple. The people still acted corruptly. ³He built the upper gate of the LORD's house, and he built much on the wall of Ophel. ⁴Moreover he built cities in the hill country of Judah, and in the forests he built fortresses and towers. ⁵He also fought with the king of the children of Ammon, and prevailed against them. The children of Ammon gave him the same year one hundred talents ^{xxxix} of silver, ten thousand cors ^{xi} of wheat, and ten thousand cors of barley. ^{xli} The children of Ammon also gave that much to him in the second year, and in the third. ⁶So Jotham became mighty, because he ordered his ways before the LORD his God. ⁷Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and all his wars and his ways, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah. ⁸He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. ⁹Jotham slept with his

^{xxxix}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

^{xi}1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels. 10,000 cors of wheat would weigh about 1,640 metric tons.

^{xli}10,000 cors of barley would weigh about 1,310 metric tons.

cubits is about 200 yards or 184 meters.

fathers, and they buried him in David's city; and Ahaz his son reigned in his place.

28Ahaz was twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. He didn't do that which was right in the LORD's eyes, like David his father, ²but he walked in the ways of the kings of Israel, and also made molten images for the Baals. ³Moreover he burned incense in the valley of the son of Hinnom, and burned his children in the fire, according to the abominations of the nations whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel. ⁴He sacrificed and burned incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree. ⁵Therefore the LORD his God delivered him into the hand of the king of Syria. They struck him, and carried away from him a great multitude of captives, and brought them to Damascus. He was also delivered into the hand of the king of Israel, who struck him with a great slaughter. ⁶For Pekah the son of Remaliah killed in Judah one hundred twenty thousand in one day, all of them valiant men, because they had forsaken the LORD, the God of their fathers. ⁷Zichri, a mighty man of Ephraim, killed Maaseiah the king's son, Azrikam the ruler of the house, and Elkanah who was next to the king. ⁸The children of Israel carried away captive of their brothers two hundred thousand women, sons, and daughters, and also took away much plunder from them, and brought the plunder to Samaria. ⁹But a prophet of the LORD was there, whose name was Oded; and he went out to meet the army that came to Samaria, and said to them, "Behold, because the LORD, the God of your fathers, was angry with Judah, he has delivered them into your hand, and you have slain them in a rage which has reached up to heaven. ¹⁰Now you intend to degrade the children of Judah and Jerusalem as male and female slaves for yourselves. Aren't there even with you trespasses of your own against the LORD your God? ¹¹Now hear me therefore, and send back the captives that you have taken captive from your brothers, for the fierce wrath of the LORD is on you." ¹²Then some of the heads of the children of Ephraim, Azariah the son of Yochanan, Berechiah the son of Meshillemoth, Jehizkiah the son of Shallum, and Amasa the son of Hadlai, stood up against those who came from the war, ¹³and said to them, "You must not bring in the captives here, for you intend that which will bring on us a trespass against the LORD, to add to our sins and to our guilt; for our guilt is great, and there is fierce wrath against Israel." ¹⁴So the armed men left the captives and the plunder before the princes and all the assembly. ¹⁵The men who have been mentioned by name rose up and took the captives, and with the plunder clothed all who were naked among them, dressed them, gave them sandals, gave them something to eat and to drink, anointed them, carried all the feeble of them on donkeys, and brought them to Jericho,

the city of palm trees, to their brothers. Then they returned to Samaria. ¹⁶At that time King Ahaz sent to the kings of Assyria to help him. ¹⁷For again the Edomites had come and struck Judah, and carried away captives. ¹⁸The Philistines also had invaded the cities of the lowland and of the South of Judah, and had taken Beth Shemesh, Aijalon, Gederot, Soco with its villages, Timnah with its villages, and also Gimzo and its villages; and they lived there. ¹⁹For the LORD brought Judah low because of Ahaz king of Israel, because he acted without restraint in Judah and trespassed severely against the LORD. ²⁰Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria came to him and gave him trouble, but didn't strengthen him. ²¹For Ahaz took away a portion out of the LORD's house, and out of the house of the king and of the princes, and gave it to the king of Assyria; but it didn't help him. ²²In the time of his distress, he trespassed yet more against the LORD, this same King Ahaz. ²³For he sacrificed to the gods of Damascus which had defeated him. He said, "Because the gods of the kings of Syria helped them, I will sacrifice to them, that they may help me." But they were the ruin of him and of all Israel. ²⁴Ahaz gathered together the vessels of God's house, cut the vessels of God's house in pieces, and shut up the doors of the LORD's house; and he made himself altars in every corner of Jerusalem. ²⁵In every city of Judah he made high places to burn incense to other gods, and provoked the LORD, the God of his fathers, to anger. ²⁶Now the rest of his acts, and all his ways, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel. ²⁷Ahaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city, even in Jerusalem, because they didn't bring him into the tombs of the kings of Israel; and Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.

29Hezekiah began to reign when he was twenty-five years old, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abijah, the daughter of Zechariah. ²He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, according to all that David his father had done. ³In the first year of his reign, in the first month, he opened the doors of the LORD's house and repaired them. ⁴He brought in the priests and the Levites and gathered them together into the wide place on the east, ⁵and said to them, "Listen to me, you Levites! Now sanctify yourselves, and sanctify the house of the LORD, the God of your fathers, and carry the filthiness out of the holy place. ⁶For our fathers were unfaithful, and have done that which was evil in the LORD our God's sight, and have forsaken him, and have turned away their faces from the habitation of the LORD, and turned their backs. ⁷Also they have shut up the doors of the porch, and put out the lamps, and have not burned incense nor offered burnt offerings in the holy place to the God of Israel. ⁸Therefore the LORD's wrath was on Judah and Jerusalem, and he has delivered them to be tossed

back and forth, to be an astonishment and a hissing, as you see with your eyes. ⁹For behold, our fathers have fallen by the sword, and our sons and our daughters and our wives are in captivity for this. ¹⁰Now it is in my heart to make a covenant with the LORD, the God of Israel, that his fierce anger may turn away from us. ¹¹My sons, don't be negligent now; for the LORD has chosen you to stand before him, to minister to him, and that you should be his ministers and burn incense." ¹²Then the Levites arose: Mahath, the son of Amasai, and Joel the son of Azariah, of the sons of the Kohathites; and of the sons of Merari, Kish the son of Abdi, and Azariah the son of Jehallelel; and of the Gershonites, Joah the son of Zimmah, and Eden the son of Joah; ¹³and of the sons of Elizaphan, Shimri and Jeuel; and of the sons of Asaph, Zechariah and Mattaniah; ¹⁴and of the sons of Heman, Jehuel and Shimei; and of the sons of Jeduthun, Shemaiah and Uzziel. ¹⁵They gathered their brothers, sanctified themselves, and went in, according to the commandment of the king by the LORD's words, to cleanse the LORD's house. ¹⁶The priests went into the inner part of the LORD's house to cleanse it, and brought out all the uncleanness that they found in the LORD's temple into the court of the LORD's house. The Levites took it from there to carry it out to the brook Kidron. ¹⁷Now they began on the first day of the first month to sanctify, and on the eighth day of the month they came to the LORD's porch. They sanctified the LORD's house in eight days, and on the sixteenth day of the first month they finished. ¹⁸Then they went in to Hezekiah the king within the palace and said, "We have cleansed all the LORD's house, including the altar of burnt offering with all its vessels, and the table of show bread with all its vessels. ¹⁹Moreover, we have prepared and sanctified all the vessels which King Ahaz threw away in his reign when he was unfaithful. Behold, they are before the LORD's altar." ²⁰Then Hezekiah the king arose early, gathered the princes of the city, and went up to the LORD's house. ²¹They brought seven bulls, seven rams, seven lambs, and seven male goats, for a sin offering for the kingdom, for the sanctuary, and for Judah. He commanded the priests the sons of Aaron to offer them on the LORD's altar. ²²So they killed the bulls, and the priests received the blood and sprinkled it on the altar. They killed the rams and sprinkled the blood on the altar. They also killed the lambs and sprinkled the blood on the altar. ²³They brought near the male goats for the sin offering before the king and the assembly; and they laid their hands on them. ²⁴Then the priests killed them, and they made a sin offering with their blood on the altar, to make atonement for all Israel; for the king commanded that the burnt offering and the sin offering should be made for all Israel. ²⁵He set the Levites in the LORD's house with cymbals, with stringed instruments, and with harps, according to the commandment of David, of Gad the king's seer, and Nathan the prophet; for the commandment was

from the LORD by his prophets. ²⁶The Levites stood with David's instruments, and the priests with the shofars ^{xlii} . trumpets ²⁷Hezekiah commanded them to offer the burnt offering on the altar. When the burnt offering began, the LORD's song also began, along with the shofars ^{xliii} or, trumpets and instruments of David king of Israel. ²⁸All the assembly worshiped, the singers sang, and the trumpeters sounded. All this continued until the burnt offering was finished. ²⁹When they had finished offering, the king and all who were present with him bowed themselves and worshiped. ³⁰Moreover Hezekiah the king and the princes commanded the Levites to sing praises to the LORD with the words of David, and of Asaph the seer. They sang praises with gladness, and they bowed their heads and worshiped. ³¹Then Hezekiah answered, "Now you have consecrated yourselves to the LORD. Come near and bring sacrifices and thank offerings into the LORD's house." The assembly brought in sacrifices and thank offerings, and as many as were of a willing heart brought burnt offerings. ³²The number of the burnt offerings which the assembly brought was seventy bulls, one hundred rams, and two hundred lambs. All these were for a burnt offering to the LORD. ³³The consecrated things were six hundred head of cattle and three thousand sheep. ³⁴But the priests were too few, so that they could not skin all the burnt offerings. Therefore their brothers the Levites helped them until the work was ended, and until the priests had sanctified themselves, for the Levites were more upright in heart to sanctify themselves than the priests. ³⁵Also the burnt offerings were in abundance, with the fat of the peace offerings and with the drink offerings for every burnt offering. So the service of the LORD's house was set in order. ³⁶Hezekiah and all the people rejoiced because of that which God had prepared for the people; for the thing was done suddenly.

30Hezekiah sent to all Israel and Judah, and wrote letters also to Ephraim and Manasseh, that they should come to the LORD's house at Jerusalem, to keep the Passover to the LORD, the God of Israel. ²For the king had taken counsel with his princes and all the assembly in Jerusalem to keep the Passover in the second month. ³For they could not keep it at that time, because the priests had not sanctified themselves in sufficient number, and the people had not gathered themselves together to Jerusalem. ⁴The thing was right in the eyes of the king and of all the assembly. ⁵So they established a decree to make proclamation throughout all Israel, from Beersheba even to Dan, that they should come to keep the Passover to the LORD, the God of Israel, at Jerusalem, for they had not kept it in great numbers in the way it is written. ⁶So the couriers went with the letters from the king and his princes throughout all Israel and Judah, according to the commandment

^{xlii}trumpets.

^{xliii}or, trumpets

of the king, saying, "You children of Israel, turn again to the LORD, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, that he may return to the remnant of you that have escaped out of the hand of the kings of Assyria. ⁷Don't be like your fathers and like your brothers, who trespassed against the LORD, the God of their fathers, so that he gave them up to desolation, as you see. ⁸Now don't be stiff-necked, as your fathers were, but yield yourselves to the LORD, and enter into his sanctuary, which he has sanctified forever, and serve the LORD your God, that his fierce anger may turn away from you. ⁹For if you turn again to the LORD, your brothers and your children will find compassion with those who led them captive, and will come again into this land, because the LORD your God is gracious and merciful, and will not turn away his face from you if you return to him." ¹⁰So the couriers passed from city to city through the country of Ephraim and Manasseh, even to Zebulun, but people ridiculed them and mocked them. ¹¹Nevertheless some men of Asher, Manasseh, and Zebulun humbled themselves and came to Jerusalem. ¹²Also the hand of God came on Judah to give them one heart, to do the commandment of the king and of the princes by the LORD's word. ¹³Many people assembled at Jerusalem to keep the feast of unleavened bread in the second month, a very great assembly. ¹⁴They arose and took away the altars that were in Jerusalem, and they took away all the altars for incense and threw them into the brook Kidron. ¹⁵Then they killed the Passover on the fourteenth day of the second month. The priests and the Levites were ashamed, and sanctified themselves, and brought burnt offerings into the LORD's house. ¹⁶They stood in their place after their order, according to the Torah of Moses the man of God. The priests sprinkled the blood which they received of the hand of the Levites. ¹⁷For there were many in the assembly who had not sanctified themselves; therefore the Levites were in charge of killing the Passovers for everyone who was not clean, to sanctify them to the LORD. ¹⁸For a multitude of the people, even many of Ephraim, Manasseh, Issachar, and Zebulun, had not cleansed themselves, yet they ate the Passover other than the way it is written. For Hezekiah had prayed for them, saying, "May the good LORD pardon everyone ¹⁹who sets his heart to seek God, the LORD, the God of his fathers, even if they aren't clean according to the purification of the sanctuary." ²⁰The LORD listened to Hezekiah, and healed the people. ²¹The children of Israel who were present at Jerusalem kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with great gladness. The Levites and the priests praised the LORD day by day, singing with loud instruments to the LORD. ²²Hezekiah spoke encouragingly to all the Levites who had good understanding in the service of the LORD. So they ate throughout the feast for the seven days, offering sacrifices of peace offerings and making confession to the LORD, the God of their fathers. ²³The whole assembly took coun-

sel to keep another seven days, and they kept another seven days with gladness. ²⁴For Hezekiah king of Judah gave to the assembly for offerings one thousand bulls and seven thousand sheep; and the princes gave to the assembly a thousand bulls and ten thousand sheep; and a great number of priests sanctified themselves. ²⁵All the assembly of Judah, with the priests and the Levites, and all the assembly who came out of Israel, and the foreigners who came out of Eretz-Israel and who lived in Judah, rejoiced. ²⁶So there was great joy in Jerusalem; for since the time of Solomon the son of David king of Israel there was nothing like this in Jerusalem. ²⁷Then the Levitical priests arose and blessed the people. Their voice was heard, and their prayer came up to his holy habitation, even to heaven.

31Now when all this was finished, all Israel who were present went out to the cities of Judah and broke the pillars in pieces, cut down the Asherah poles, and broke down the high places and the altars out of all Judah and Benjamin, also in Ephraim and Manasseh, until they had destroyed them all. Then all the children of Israel returned, every man to his possession, into their own cities. ²Hezekiah appointed the divisions of the priests and the Levites after their divisions, every man according to his service, both the priests and the Levites, for burnt offerings and for peace offerings, to minister, to give thanks, and to praise in the gates of the LORD's camp. ³He also appointed the king's portion of his possessions for the burnt offerings: for the morning and evening burnt offerings, and the burnt offerings for the Sabbaths, for the new moons, and for the set feasts, as it is written in the LORD's law. ⁴Moreover he commanded the people who lived in Jerusalem to give the portion of the priests and the Levites, that they might give themselves to the LORD's law. ⁵As soon as the commandment went out, the children of Israel gave in abundance the first fruits of grain, new wine, oil, honey, and of all the increase of the field; and they brought in the tithe of all things abundantly. ⁶The children of Israel and Judah, who lived in the cities of Judah, also brought in the tithe of cattle and sheep, and the tithe of dedicated things which were consecrated to the LORD their God, and laid them in heaps. ⁷In the third month, they began to lay the foundation of the heaps, and finished them in the seventh month. ⁸When Hezekiah and the princes came and saw the heaps, they blessed the LORD and his people Israel. ⁹Then Hezekiah questioned the priests and the Levites about the heaps. ¹⁰Azariah the chief priest, of the house of Zadok, answered him and said, "Since people began to bring the offerings into the LORD's house, we have eaten and had enough, and have plenty left over, for the LORD has blessed his people; and that which is left is this great store." ¹¹Then Hezekiah commanded them to prepare rooms in the LORD's house, and they prepared them. ¹²They brought in the offerings,

the tithes, and the dedicated things faithfully. Conaniah the Levite was ruler over them, and Shimei his brother was second. ¹³Jehiel, Azaziah, Nahath, Asahel, Jerimoth, Jozabad, Eliel, Ismachiah, Mahath, and Benaiah were overseers under the hand of Conaniah and Shimei his brother, by the appointment of Hezekiah the king and Azariah the ruler of God's house. ¹⁴Kore the son of Imnah the Levite, the gatekeeper at the east gate, was over the free will offerings of God, to distribute the LORD's offerings and the most holy things. ¹⁵Under him were Eden, Miniamin, Yeshua, Shemaiah, Amariah, and Shecaniah, in the cities of the priests, in their office of trust, to give to their brothers by divisions, to the great as well as to the small; ¹⁶in addition to those who were listed by genealogy of males, from three years old and upward, even everyone who entered into the LORD's house, as the duty of every day required, for their service in their offices according to their divisions; ¹⁷and those who were listed by genealogy of the priests by their fathers' houses, and the Levites from twenty years old and upward, in their offices by their divisions; ¹⁸and those who were listed by genealogy of all their little ones, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, through all the congregation; for in their office of trust they sanctified themselves in holiness. ¹⁹Also for the sons of Aaron the priests, who were in the fields of the pasture lands of their cities, in every city, there were men who were mentioned by name to give portions to all the males among the priests and to all who were listed by genealogy among the Levites. ²⁰Hezekiah did so throughout all Judah; and he did that which was good, right, and faithful before the LORD his God. ²¹In every work that he began in the service of God's house, in the law, and in the commandments, to seek his God, he did it with all his heart and prospered.

32After these things and this faithfulness, Sennacherib king of Assyria came, entered into Judah, encamped against the fortified cities, and intended to win them for himself. ²When Hezekiah saw that Sennacherib had come, and that he was planning to fight against Jerusalem, ³he took counsel with his princes and his mighty men to stop the waters of the springs which were outside of the city, and they helped him. ⁴Then many people gathered together and they stopped all the springs and the brook that flowed through the middle of the land, saying, "Why should the kings of Assyria come, and find abundant water?" ⁵He took courage, built up all the wall that was broken down, and raised it up to the towers, with the other wall outside, and strengthened Millo in David's city, and made weapons and shields in abundance. ⁶He set captains of war over the people, gathered them together to him in the wide place at the gate of the city, and spoke encouragingly to them, saying, ⁷"Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid or dismayed because of the king of Assyria, nor for all the multitude who is with him; for there is a greater

one with us than with him. ⁸An arm of flesh is with him, but the LORD our God is with us to help us and to fight our battles." The people rested themselves on the words of Hezekiah king of Judah. ⁹After this, Sennacherib king of Assyria sent his servants to Jerusalem, (now he was attacking Lachish, and all his forces were with him), to Hezekiah king of Judah, and to all Judah who were at Jerusalem, saying, ¹⁰Sennacherib king of Assyria says, "In whom do you trust, that you remain under siege in Jerusalem?" ¹¹Doesn't Hezekiah persuade you to give you over to die by famine and by thirst, saying, 'The LORD our God will deliver us out of the hand of the king of Assyria?' ¹²Hasn't the same Hezekiah taken away his high places and his altars, and commanded Judah and Jerusalem, saying, 'You shall worship before one altar, and you shall burn incense on it?' ¹³Don't you know what I and my fathers have done to all the peoples of the lands? Were the gods of the nations of those lands in any way able to deliver their land out of my hand? ¹⁴Who was there among all the gods of those nations which my fathers utterly destroyed that could deliver his people out of my hand, that your God should be able to deliver you out of my hand? ¹⁵Now therefore don't let Hezekiah deceive you nor persuade you in this way. Don't believe him, for no god of any nation or kingdom was able to deliver his people out of my hand, and out of the hand of my fathers. How much less will your God deliver you out of my hand?" ¹⁶His servants spoke yet more against the LORD God and against his servant Hezekiah. ¹⁷He also wrote letters insulting the LORD, the God of Israel, and speaking against him, saying, "As the gods of the nations of the lands, which have not delivered their people out of my hand, so shall the God of Hezekiah not deliver his people out of my hand." ¹⁸They called out with a loud voice in the Jews' language to the people of Jerusalem who were on the wall, to frighten them and to trouble them, that they might take the city. ¹⁹They spoke of the God of Jerusalem as of the gods of the peoples of the earth, which are the work of men's hands. ²⁰Hezekiah the king and Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, prayed because of this, and cried to heaven. ²¹The LORD sent an angel, who cut off all the mighty men of valor, the leaders, and captains in the camp of the king of Assyria. So he returned with shame of face to his own land. When he had come into the house of his god, those who came out of his own body ^{xliv} killed him there with the sword. ²²Thus the LORD saved Hezekiah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherib the king of Assyria and from the hand of all others, and guided them on every side. ²³Many brought gifts to the LORD to Jerusalem, and precious things to Hezekiah king of Judah, so that he was exalted in the sight of all nations from then on. ²⁴In those days Hezekiah was terminally ill, and he prayed to the LORD; and he spoke to him, and gave him a sign. ²⁵But Hezekiah didn't reciprocate appropriate to

^{xliv}i.e., his own sons

the benefit done for him, because his heart was lifted up. Therefore there was wrath on him, Judah, and Jerusalem. ²⁶However, Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both he and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that the LORD's wrath didn't come on them in the days of Hezekiah. ²⁷Hezekiah had exceedingly great riches and honor. He provided himself with treasuries for silver, for gold, for precious stones, for spices, for shields, and for all kinds of valuable vessels; ²⁸also storehouses for the increase of grain, new wine, and oil; and stalls for all kinds of animals, and flocks in folds. ²⁹Moreover he provided for himself cities, and possessions of flocks and herds in abundance; for God had given him abundant possessions. ³⁰This same Hezekiah also stopped the upper spring of the waters of Gihon, and brought them straight down on the west side of David's city. Hezekiah prospered in all his works. ³¹However, concerning the ambassadors of the princes of Babylon, who sent to him to inquire of the wonder that was done in the land, God left him to test him, that he might know all that was in his heart. ³²Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah and his good deeds, behold, they are written in the vision of Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel. ³³Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the ascent to the tombs of the sons of David. All Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem honored him at his death. Manasseh his son reigned in his place.

33Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, after the abominations of the nations whom the LORD cast out before the children of Israel. ³For he built again the high places which Hezekiah his father had broken down; and he raised up altars for the Baals, made Asheroth, and worshiped all the army of the sky, and served them. ⁴He built altars in the LORD's house, of which the LORD said, "My name shall be in Jerusalem forever." ⁵He built altars for all the army of the sky in the two courts of the LORD's house. ⁶He also made his children to pass through the fire in the valley of the son of Hinnom. He practiced sorcery, divination, and witchcraft, and dealt with those who had familiar spirits and with wizards. He did much evil in the LORD's sight, to provoke him to anger. ⁷He set the engraved image of the idol, which he had made, in God's house, of which God said to David and to Solomon his son, "In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever. ⁸I will not any more remove the foot of Israel from off the land which I have appointed for your fathers, if only they will observe to do all that I have commanded them, even all the law, the statutes, and the ordinances given by Moses." ⁹Manasseh seduced Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that they did more evil than did the nations

whom the LORD destroyed before the children of Israel. ¹⁰The LORD spoke to Manasseh and to his people, but they didn't listen. ¹¹Therefore the LORD brought on them the captains of the army of the king of Assyria, who took Manasseh in chains, bound him with fetters, and carried him to Babylon. ¹²When he was in distress, he begged the LORD his God, and humbled himself greatly before the God of his fathers. ¹³He prayed to him; and he was entreated by him, and heard his supplication, and brought him again to Jerusalem into his kingdom. Then Manasseh knew that the LORD was God. ¹⁴Now after this, he built an outer wall to David's city on the west side of Gihon, in the valley, even to the entrance at the fish gate. He encircled Ophel with it, and raised it up to a very great height; and he put valiant captains in all the fortified cities of Judah. ¹⁵He took away the foreign gods and the idol out of the LORD's house, and all the altars that he had built in the mountain of the LORD's house and in Jerusalem, and cast them out of the city. ¹⁶He built up the LORD's altar, and offered sacrifices of peace offerings and of thanksgiving on it, and commanded Judah to serve the LORD, the God of Israel. ¹⁷Nevertheless the people still sacrificed in the high places, but only to the LORD their God. ¹⁸Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh, and his prayer to his God, and the words of the seers who spoke to him in the name of the LORD, the God of Israel, behold, they are written among the acts of the kings of Israel. ¹⁹His prayer also, and how God listened to his request, and all his sin and his trespass, and the places in which he built high places and set up the Asherah poles and the engraved images before he humbled himself: behold, they are written in the history of Hozai. ^{xlv} ²⁰So Manasseh slept with his fathers, and they buried him in his own house; and Amon his son reigned in his place. ²¹Amon was twenty-two years old when he began to reign; and he reigned two years in Jerusalem. ²²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, as did Manasseh his father; and Amon sacrificed to all the engraved images which Manasseh his father had made, and served them. ²³He didn't humble himself before the LORD, as Manasseh his father had humbled himself; but this same Amon trespassed more and more. ²⁴His servants conspired against him, and put him to death in his own house. ²⁵But the people of the land killed all those who had conspired against King Amon; and the people of the land made Josiah his son king in his place.

34Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem. ²He did that which was right in the LORD's eyes, and walked in the ways of David his father, and didn't turn away to the right hand or to the left. ³For in the eighth year of his reign, while he was yet young, he began to seek after the God of David his father; and in the twelfth year he be-

^{xlv}or, the seers

gan to purge Judah and Jerusalem from the high places, the Asherah poles, the engraved images, and the molten images. ⁴They broke down the altars of the Baals in his presence; and he cut down the incense altars that were on high above them. He broke the Asherah poles, the engraved images, and the molten images in pieces, made dust of them, and scattered it on the graves of those who had sacrificed to them. ⁵He burned the bones of the priests on their altars, and purged Judah and Jerusalem. ⁶He did this in the cities of Manasseh, Ephraim, and Simeon, even to Naphtali, around in their ruins. ⁷He broke down the altars, beat the Asherah poles and the engraved images into powder, and cut down all the incense altars throughout all Eretz-Israel, then returned to Jerusalem. ⁸Now in the eighteenth year of his reign, when he had purged the land and the house, he sent Shaphan the son of Azaliah, Maaseiah the governor of the city, and Joah the son of Joahaz the recorder to repair the house of the LORD his God. ⁹They came to Hilkiah the high priest and delivered the money that was brought into God's house, which the Levites, the keepers of the threshold, had gathered from the hands of Manasseh, Ephraim, of all the remnant of Israel, of all Judah and Benjamin, and of the inhabitants of Jerusalem. ¹⁰They delivered it into the hands of the workmen who had the oversight of the LORD's house; and the workmen who labored in the LORD's house gave it to mend and repair the house. ¹¹They gave it to the carpenters and to the builders to buy cut stone and timber for couplings, and to make beams for the houses which the kings of Judah had destroyed. ¹²The men did the work faithfully. Their overseers were Jahath and Obadiah the Levites, of the sons of Merari; and Zechariah and Meshullam, of the sons of the Kohathites, to give direction; and others of the Levites, who were all skillful with musical instruments. ¹³Also they were over the bearers of burdens, and directed all who did the work in every kind of service. Of the Levites, there were scribes, officials, and gatekeepers. ¹⁴When they brought out the money that was brought into the LORD's house, Hilkiah the priest found the book of the LORD's law given by Moses. ¹⁵Hilkiah answered Shaphan the scribe, "I have found the scroll of the Torah in the LORD's house." So Hilkiah delivered the book to Shaphan. ¹⁶Shaphan carried the book to the king, and moreover brought back word to the king, saying, "All that was committed to your servants, they are doing. ¹⁷They have emptied out the money that was found in the LORD's house, and have delivered it into the hand of the overseers and into the hand of the workmen." ¹⁸Shaphan the scribe told the king, saying, "Hilkiah the priest has delivered me a book." Shaphan read from it to the king. ¹⁹When the king had heard the words of the law, he tore his clothes. ²⁰The king commanded Hilkiah, Ahikam the son of Shaphan, Abdon the son of Micah, Shaphan the scribe, and Asaiah the king's servant, saying, ²¹"Go in-

quire of the LORD for me, and for those who are left in Israel and in Judah, concerning the words of the book that is found; for great is the LORD's wrath that is poured out on us, because our fathers have not kept the LORD's word, to do according to all that is written in this book." ²²So Hilkiah and those whom the king had commanded went to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of Tokhath, the son of Hasrah, keeper of the wardrobe (now she lived in Jerusalem in the second quarter), and they spoke to her to that effect. ²³She said to them, "The LORD, the God of Israel says: 'Tell the man who sent you to me, ²⁴'The LORD says, 'Behold, I will bring evil on this place and on its inhabitants, even all the curses that are written in the book which they have read before the king of Judah. ²⁵Because they have forsaken me, and have burned incense to other gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands, therefore my wrath is poured out on this place, and it will not be quenched.'"²⁶But to the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of the LORD, you shall tell him this, 'The LORD, the God of Israel says: "About the words which you have heard, ²⁷because your heart was tender, and you humbled yourself before God when you heard his words against this place and against its inhabitants, and have humbled yourself before me, and have torn your clothes and wept before me, I also have heard you," says the LORD. ²⁸"Behold, I will gather you to your fathers, and you will be gathered to your grave in peace. Your eyes won't see all the evil that I will bring on this place and on its inhabitants."'"²⁹They brought back this message to the king. ²⁹Then the king sent and gathered together all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem. ³⁰The king went up to the LORD's house with all the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem—the priests, the Levites, and all the people, both great and small—and he read in their hearing all the words of the book of the covenant that was found in the LORD's house. ³¹The king stood in his place and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments, his testimonies, and his statutes with all his heart and with all his soul, to perform the words of the covenant that were written in this book. ³²He caused all who were found in Jerusalem and Benjamin to stand. The inhabitants of Jerusalem did according to the covenant of God, the God of their fathers. ³³Josiah took away all the abominations out of all the countries that belonged to the children of Israel, and made all who were found in Israel to serve, even to serve the LORD their God. All his days they didn't depart from following the LORD, the God of their fathers.

35Josiah kept a Passover to the LORD in Jerusalem. They killed the Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month. ²He set the priests in their offices and encouraged them in the service of the LORD's house. ³He said to the

Levites who taught all Israel, who were holy to the LORD, “Put the holy ark in the house which Solomon the son of David king of Israel built. It will no longer be a burden on your shoulders. Now serve the LORD your God and his people Israel. ⁴Prepare yourselves after your fathers’ houses by your divisions, according to the writing of David king of Israel, and according to the writing of Solomon his son. ⁵Stand in the holy place according to the divisions of the fathers’ houses of your brothers the children of the people, and let there be for each a portion of a fathers’ house of the Levites. ⁶Kill the Passover lamb, sanctify yourselves, and prepare for your brothers, to do according to the LORD’s word by Moses.” ⁷Josiah gave to the children of the people, of the flock, lambs and young goats, all of them for the Passover offerings, to all who were present, to the number of thirty thousand, and three thousand bulls. These were of the king’s substance. ⁸His princes gave a free will offering to the people, to the priests, and to the Levites. Hilkiah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, the rulers of God’s house, gave to the priests for the Passover offerings two thousand six hundred small livestock, and three hundred head of cattle. ⁹Conaniah also, and Shemaiah and Nethanel, his brothers, and Hashabiah, Jeiel, and Jozabad, the chiefs of the Levites, gave to the Levites for the Passover offerings five thousand small livestock and five hundred head of cattle. ¹⁰So the service was prepared, and the priests stood in their place, and the Levites by their divisions, according to the king’s commandment. ¹¹They killed the Passover lambs, and the priests sprinkled the blood which they received from their hands, and the Levites skinned them. ¹²They removed the burnt offerings, that they might give them according to the divisions of the fathers’ houses of the children of the people, to offer to the LORD, as it is written in the book of Moses. They did the same with the cattle. ¹³They roasted the Passover with fire according to the ordinance. They boiled the holy offerings in pots, in cauldrons, and in pans, and carried them quickly to all the children of the people. ¹⁴Afterward they prepared for themselves and for the priests, because the priests the sons of Aaron were busy with offering the burnt offerings and the fat until night. Therefore the Levites prepared for themselves and for the priests the sons of Aaron. ¹⁵The singers, the sons of Asaph, were in their place, according to the commandment of David, Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun the king’s seer; and the gatekeepers were at every gate. They didn’t need to depart from their service, because their brothers the Levites prepared for them. ¹⁶So all the service of the LORD was prepared the same day, to keep the Passover, and to offer burnt offerings on the LORD’s altar, according to the commandment of King Josiah. ¹⁷The children of Israel who were present kept the Passover at that time, and the feast of unleavened bread seven days. ¹⁸There was no Passover like that kept in Israel from the days of Samuel the prophet, nor did any of the kings of Israel keep such a

Passover as Josiah kept—with the priests, the Levites, and all Judah and Israel who were present, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem. ¹⁹This Passover was kept in the eighteenth year of the reign of Josiah. ²⁰After all this, when Josiah had prepared the temple, Neco king of Egypt went up to fight against Carchemish by the Euphrates, and Josiah went out against him. ²¹But he sent ambassadors to him, saying, “What have I to do with you, you king of Judah? I come not against you today, but against the house with which I have war. God has commanded me to make haste. Beware that it is God who is with me, that he not destroy you.” ²²Nevertheless Josiah would not turn his face from him, but disguised himself, that he might fight with him, and didn’t listen to the words of Neco from the mouth of God, and came to fight in the valley of Megiddo. ²³The archers shot at King Josiah; and the king said to his servants, “Take me away, because I am seriously wounded!” ²⁴So his servants took him out of the chariot, and put him in the second chariot that he had, and brought him to Jerusalem; and he died, and was buried in the tombs of his fathers. All Judah and Jerusalem mourned for Josiah. ²⁵Jeremiah lamented for Josiah, and all the singing men and singing women spoke of Josiah in their lamentations to this day; and they made them an ordinance in Israel. Behold, they are written in the lamentations. ²⁶Now the rest of the acts of Josiah and his good deeds, according to that which is written in the LORD’s law, ²⁷and his acts, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

36Then the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and made him king in his father’s place in Jerusalem. ²Joahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. ³The king of Egypt removed him from office at Jerusalem, and fined the land one hundred talents of silver and a talent ^{xlvi} of gold. ⁴The king of Egypt made Eliakim his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem, and changed his name to Jehoiakim. Neco took Joahaz his brother, and carried him to Egypt. ⁵Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. He did that which was evil in the LORD his God’s sight. ⁶Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up against him, and bound him in fetters to carry him to Babylon. ⁷Nebuchadnezzar also carried some of the vessels of the LORD’s house to Babylon, and put them in his temple at Babylon. ⁸Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and his abominations which he did, and that which was found in him, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah; and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place. ⁹Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem. He did that which was evil in the LORD’s

^{xlvi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

sight. ¹⁰At the return of the year, King Nebuchadnezzar sent and brought him to Babylon, with the valuable vessels of the LORD's house, and made Zedekiah his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem. ¹¹Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. ¹²He did that which was evil in the LORD his God's sight. He didn't humble himself before Jeremiah the prophet speaking from the LORD's mouth. ¹³He also rebelled against King Nebuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by God; but he stiffened his neck, and hardened his heart against turning to the LORD, the God of Israel. ¹⁴Moreover all the chiefs of the priests and the people trespassed very greatly after all the abominations of the nations; and they polluted the LORD's house which he had made holy in Jerusalem. ¹⁵The LORD, the God of their fathers, sent to them by his messengers, rising up early and sending, because he had compassion on his people and on his dwelling place; ¹⁶but they mocked the messengers of God, despised his words, and scoffed at his prophets, until the LORD's wrath arose against his people, until there was no remedy. ¹⁷Therefore he brought on them the king of the Kasdim, who killed their young men with the sword in the house of their sanctuary, and had no compassion on young man or virgin, old man or infirm. He gave them all into his hand. ¹⁸All the vessels of God's house, great and small, and the treasures of the LORD's house, and the treasures of the king and of his princes, all these he brought to Babylon. ¹⁹They burned God's house, broke down the wall of Jerusalem, burned all its palaces with fire, and destroyed all of its valuable vessels. ²⁰He carried those who had escaped from the sword away to Babylon, and they were servants to him and his sons until the reign of the kingdom of Persia, ²¹to fulfill the LORD's word by Jeremiah's mouth, until the land had enjoyed its Sabbaths. As long as it lay desolate, it kept Sabbath, to fulfill seventy years. ²²Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the LORD's word by the mouth of Jeremiah might be accomplished, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, so that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying, ²³"Cyrus king of Persia says, 'The LORD, the God of heaven, has given all the kingdoms of the earth to me; and he has commanded me to build him a house in Jerusalem, which is in Judah. Whoever there is among you of all his people, the LORD his God be with him, and let him go up.'"

Ezra

¹Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the LORD's ⁱ word by Jeremiah's mouth might be accomplished, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, so that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying, ²"Cyrus king of Persia says, 'The LORD, the God ⁱⁱ of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth; and he has commanded me to build him a house in Jerusalem, which is in Judah. ³Whoever there is among you of all his people, may his God be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and build the house of the LORD, the God of Israel (he is God), which is in Jerusalem. ⁴Whoever is left, in any place where he lives, let the men of his place help him with silver, with gold, with goods, and with animals, in addition to the free will offering for God's house which is in Jerusalem.'" ⁵Then the heads of fathers' households of Judah and Benjamin, the priests and the Levites, all whose spirit God had stirred to go up, rose up to build the LORD's house which is in Jerusalem. ⁶All those who were around them strengthened their hands with vessels of silver, with gold, with goods, with animals, and with precious things, in addition to all that was willingly offered. ⁷Also Cyrus the king brought out the vessels of the LORD's house, which Nebuchadnezzar had brought out of Jerusalem, and had put in the house of his gods; ⁸even those, Cyrus king of Persia brought out by the hand of Mithredath the treasurer, and counted them out to Sheshbazzar the prince of Judah. ⁹This is the number of them: thirty platters of gold, one thousand platters of silver, twenty-nine knives, ¹⁰thirty bowls of gold, four hundred ten silver bowls of a second kind, and one thousand other vessels. ¹¹All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand four hundred. Sheshbazzar brought all these up when the captives were brought up from Babylon to Jerusalem.

²Now these are the children of the province who went up out of the captivity of those who had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away to Babylon, and who returned to Jerusalem and Ju-

dah, everyone to his city; ²who came with Zerubbabel, Yeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, and Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel: ³The children of Parosh, two thousand one hundred seventy-two. ⁴The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy-two. ⁵The children of Arah, seven hundred seventy-five. ⁶The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Yeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred twelve. ⁷The children of Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. ⁸The children of Zattu, nine hundred forty-five. ⁹The children of Zaccai, seven hundred sixty. ¹⁰The children of Bani, six hundred forty-two. ¹¹The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty-three. ¹²The children of Azgad, one thousand two hundred twenty-two. ¹³The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-six. ¹⁴The children of Bigvai, two thousand fifty-six. ¹⁵The children of Adin, four hundred fifty-four. ¹⁶The children of Ater, of Hezekiah, ninety-eight. ¹⁷The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty-three. ¹⁸The children of Jorah, one hundred twelve. ¹⁹The children of Hashum, two hundred twenty-three. ²⁰The children of Gibbar, ninety-five. ²¹The children of Bethlehem, one hundred twenty-three. ²²The men of Netophah, fifty-six. ²³The men of Anathoth, one hundred twenty-eight. ²⁴The children of Azmaveth, forty-two. ²⁵The children of Kiriath Arim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred forty-three. ²⁶The children of Ramah and Geba, six hundred twenty-one. ²⁷The men of Michmas, one hundred twenty-two. ²⁸The men of Bethel and Ai, two hundred twenty-three. ²⁹The children of Nebo, fifty-two. ³⁰The children of Magbish, one hundred fifty-six. ³¹The children of the other Elam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. ³²The children of Harim, three hundred twenty. ³³The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty-five. ³⁴The children of Jericho, three hundred forty-five. ³⁵The children of Senaah, three thousand six hundred thirty. ³⁶The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Yeshua, nine hundred seventy-three. ³⁷The children of Immer, one thousand fifty-two. ³⁸The children of Pashhur, one thousand two hundred forty-seven. ³⁹The children of Harim, one thousand seventeen. ⁴⁰The Levites: the children of Yeshua and Kadmiel, of the children of Hodaviah, seventy-four. ⁴¹The singers: the children of Asaph, one hundred twenty-eight. ⁴²The children of the gate-

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

keepers: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, in all one hundred thirty-nine. ⁴³The temple servants: the children of Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the children of Tabbaoth, ⁴⁴the children of Keros, the children of Siaha, the children of Padon, ⁴⁵the children of Lebanah, the children of Hagabah, the children of Akkub, ⁴⁶the children of Hagab, the children of Sham-lai, the children of Hanan, ⁴⁷the children of Giddel, the children of Gahar, the children of Reaiah, ⁴⁸the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda, the children of Gazzam, ⁴⁹the children of Uzza, the children of Paseah, the children of Besai, ⁵⁰the children of Asnah, the children of Meunim, the children of Nephisim, ⁵¹the children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur, ⁵²the children of Bazluth, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha, ⁵³the children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Temah, ⁵⁴the children of Nezhiah, the children of Hatipha. ⁵⁵The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Hassophereth, the children of Peruda, ⁵⁶the children of Jaalah, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel, ⁵⁷the children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth Hazzebaim, the children of Ami. ⁵⁸All the temple servants, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety-two. ⁵⁹These were those who went up from Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Cherub, Addan, and Immer; but they could not show their fathers' houses and their offspring, ⁱⁱⁱ whether they were of Israel: ⁶⁰the children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty-two. ⁶¹Of the children of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Hakkoz, and the children of Barzillai, who took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name. ⁶²These sought their place among those who were registered by genealogy, but they were not found; therefore they were deemed disqualified and removed from the priesthood. ⁶³The governor told them that they should not eat of the most holy things until a priest stood up to serve with Urim and with Thummim. ⁶⁴The whole assembly together was forty-two thousand three hundred sixty, ⁶⁵in addition to their male servants and their female servants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven; and they had two hundred singing men and singing women. ⁶⁶Their horses were seven hundred thirty-six; their mules, two hundred forty-five; ⁶⁷their camels, four hundred thirty-five; their donkeys, six thousand seven hundred twenty. ⁶⁸Some of the heads of fathers' households, when they came to the LORD's house which is in Jerusalem, offered willingly for God's house to set it up in its place. ⁶⁹They gave according to their ability into the treasury of the work sixty-one

thousand darics of gold, ^{iv} five thousand minas ^v of silver, and one hundred priests' garments. ⁷⁰So the priests and the Levites, with some of the people, the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants, lived in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

3When the seventh month had come, and the children of Israel were in the cities, the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem. ²Then Yeshua the son of Jozadak stood up with his brothers the priests and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and his relatives, and built the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings on it, as it is written in the Torah of Moses the man of God. ³In spite of their fear because of the peoples of the surrounding lands, they set the altar on its base; and they offered burnt offerings on it to the LORD, even burnt offerings morning and evening. ⁴They kept the feast of booths, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number, according to the ordinance, as the duty of every day required; ⁵and afterward the continual burnt offering, the offerings of the new moons, of all the set feasts of the LORD that were consecrated, and of everyone who willingly offered a free will offering to the LORD. ⁶From the first day of the seventh month, they began to offer burnt offerings to the LORD; but the foundation of the LORD's temple was not yet laid. ⁷They also gave money to the masons and to the carpenters. They also gave food, drink, and oil to the people of Sidon and Tyre to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea, to Joppa, according to the grant that they had from Cyrus King of Persia. ⁸Now in the second year of their coming to God's house at Jerusalem, in the second month, Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, Yeshua the son of Jozadak, and the rest of their brothers the priests and the Levites, and all those who had come out of the captivity to Jerusalem, began the work and appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to have the oversight of the work of the LORD's house. ⁹Then Yeshua stood with his sons and his brothers, Kadmiel and his sons, the sons of Judah, together to have the oversight of the workmen in God's house: the sons of Henadad, with their sons and their brothers the Levites. ¹⁰When the builders laid the foundation of the LORD's temple, they set the priests in their vestments with shofars ^{vi}, or, trumpets with the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise the LORD, according to the directions of David king of Israel. ¹¹They sang to one another in praising and giving thanks to the LORD, "For he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever toward Israel." All the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the LORD's house

^{iv}a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

^vA mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds, so 5,000 minas is about 3 metric tons.

^{vi}or, trumpets,

ⁱⁱⁱor, seed

had been laid. ¹²But many of the priests and Levites and heads of fathers' households, the old men who had seen the first house, when the foundation of this house was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice. Many also shouted aloud for joy, ¹³so that the people could not discern the noise of the shout of joy from the noise of the weeping of the people; for the people shouted with a loud shout, and the noise was heard far away.

⁴Now when the adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the children of the captivity were building a temple to the LORD, the God of Israel, ²they came near to Zerubbabel, and to the heads of fathers' households, and said to them, "Let us build with you, for we seek your God as you do; and we have been sacrificing to him since the days of Esar Haddon king of Assyria, who brought us up here." ³But Zerubbabel, Yeshua, and the rest of the heads of fathers' households of Israel said to them, "You have nothing to do with us in building a house to our God; but we ourselves together will build to the LORD, the God of Israel, as King Cyrus the king of Persia has commanded us." ⁴Then the people of the land weakened the hands of the people of Judah, and troubled them in building. ⁵They hired counselors against them to frustrate their purpose all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of Persia. ⁶In the reign of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reign, they wrote an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem. ⁷In the days of Artaxerxes, Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of his companions wrote to Artaxerxes king of Persia; and the writing of the letter was written in Syrian and delivered in the Syrian language. ⁸Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king as follows. ⁹Then Rehum the chancellor, Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of their companions, the Dinaites, and the Apharsathchites, the Tarpelites, the Apharsites, the Archevites, the Babylonians, the Shushanchites, the Dehaites, the Elamites, ¹⁰and the rest of the nations whom the great and noble Osnappar brought over and settled in the city of Samaria, and in the rest of the country beyond the River, and so forth, wrote. ¹¹This is the copy of the letter that they sent: To King Artaxerxes, from your servants, the people beyond the River. ¹²Be it known to the king that the Jews who came up from you have come to us to Jerusalem. They are building the rebellious and bad city, and have finished the walls and repaired the foundations. ¹³Be it known now to the king that if this city is built and the walls finished, they will not pay tribute, custom, or toll, and in the end it will be hurtful to the kings. ¹⁴Now because we eat the salt of the palace and it is not appropriate for us to see the king's dishonor, therefore we have sent and informed the king, ¹⁵that search may be made in the book of the records of your fathers. You will see in the book of the records, and

know that this city is a rebellious city, and hurtful to kings and provinces, and that they have started rebellions within it in the past. That is why this city was destroyed. ¹⁶We inform the king that if this city is built and the walls finished, then you will have no possession beyond the River. ¹⁷Then the king sent an answer to Rehum the chancellor, and to Shimshai the scribe, and to the rest of their companions who live in Samaria, and in the rest of the country beyond the River: Peace. ¹⁸The letter which you sent to us has been plainly read before me. ¹⁹I decreed, and search has been made, and it was found that this city has made insurrection against kings in the past, and that rebellion and revolts have been made in it. ²⁰There have also been mighty kings over Jerusalem who have ruled over all the country beyond the River; and tribute, custom, and toll was paid to them. ²¹Make a decree now to cause these men to cease, and that this city not be built until a decree is made by me. ²²Be careful that you not be slack doing so. Why should damage grow to the hurt of the kings? ²³Then when the copy of King Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum, Shimshai the scribe, and their companions, they went in haste to Jerusalem to the Jews, and made them to cease by force of arms. ²⁴Then work stopped on God's house which is at Jerusalem. It stopped until the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.

⁵Now the prophets, Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied to the Jews who were in Judah and Jerusalem. They prophesied to them in the name of the God of Israel. ²Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Yeshua the son of Jozadak rose up and began to build God's house which is at Jerusalem; and with them were the prophets of God, helping them. ³At the same time Tattenai, the governor beyond the River, came to them, with Shetharbozenai and their companions, and asked them, "Who gave you a decree to build this house and to finish this wall?" ⁴They also asked for the names of the men who were making this building. ⁵But the eye of their God was on the Jewish elders, and they didn't make them cease until the matter should come to Darius, and an answer should be returned by letter concerning it. ⁶The copy of the letter that Tattenai, the governor beyond the River, and Shetharbozenai, and his companions the Apharsachites who were beyond the River, sent to Darius the king follows. ⁷They sent a letter to him, in which was written: To Darius the king, all peace. ⁸Be it known to the king that we went into the province of Judah, to the house of the great God, which is being built with great stones and timber is laid in the walls. This work goes on with diligence and prospers in their hands. ⁹Then we asked those elders, and said to them thus, "Who gave you a decree to build this house, and to finish this wall?" ¹⁰We asked them their names also, to inform you that we might write the names of the men who were at their head. ¹¹Thus

they returned us answer, saying, “We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth and are building the house that was built these many years ago, which a great king of Israel built and finished. ¹²But after our fathers had provoked the God of heaven to wrath, he gave them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, the Kasdian, who destroyed this house and carried the people away into Babylon. ¹³But in the first year of Cyrus king of Babylon, Cyrus the king made a decree to build this house of God. ¹⁴The gold and silver vessels of God’s house, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple that was in Jerusalem and brought into the temple of Babylon, those Cyrus the king also took out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered to one whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor. ¹⁵He said to him, ‘Take these vessels, go, put them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let God’s house be built in its place.’ ¹⁶Then the same Sheshbazzar came and laid the foundations of God’s house which is in Jerusalem. Since that time even until now it has been being built, and yet it is not completed. ¹⁷Now therefore, if it seems good to the king, let a search be made in the king’s treasure house, which is there at Babylon, whether it is so that a decree was made by Cyrus the king to build this house of God at Jerusalem; and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.”

⁶Then Darius the king made a decree, and the house of the archives, where the treasures were laid up in Babylon, was searched. ²A scroll was found at Achmetha, in the palace that is in the province of Media, and in it this was written for a record: ³In the first year of Cyrus the king, Cyrus the king made a decree: Concerning God’s house at Jerusalem, let the house be built, the place where they offer sacrifices, and let its foundations be strongly laid, with its height sixty cubits ^{vii} and its width sixty cubits; ⁴with three courses of great stones and a course of new timber. Let the expenses be given out of the king’s house. ⁵Also let the gold and silver vessels of God’s house, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple which is at Jerusalem and brought to Babylon, be restored and brought again to the temple which is at Jerusalem, everything to its place. You shall put them in God’s house. ⁶Now therefore, Tattenai, governor beyond the River, Shetharbozenai, and your companions the Apharsachites, who are beyond the River, you must stay far from there. ⁷Leave the work of this house of God alone; let the governor of the Jews and the Jewish elders build this house of God in its place. ⁸Moreover I make a decree regarding what you shall do for these Jewish elders for the building of this house of God: that of the king’s goods, even of the tribute beyond the River, expenses must be given with all diligence to these men, that they not be hindered. ⁹That which they have need of, including young

bulls, rams, and lambs, for burnt offerings to the God of heaven; also wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the word of the priests who are at Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day without fail, ¹⁰that they may offer sacrifices of pleasant aroma to the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king and of his sons. ¹¹I have also made a decree that whoever alters this message, let a beam be pulled out from his house, and let him be lifted up and fastened on it; and let his house be made a dunghill for this. ¹²May the God who has caused his name to dwell there overthrow all kings and peoples who stretch out their hand to alter this, to destroy this house of God which is at Jerusalem. I Darius have made a decree. Let it be done with all diligence. ¹³Then Tattenai, the governor beyond the River, Shetharbozenai, and their companions did accordingly with all diligence, because Darius the king had sent a decree. ¹⁴The Jewish elders built and prospered, through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. They built and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the decree of Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia. ¹⁵This house was finished on the third day of the month Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king. ¹⁶The children of Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity, kept the dedication of this house of God with joy. ¹⁷They offered at the dedication of this house of God one hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs; and for a sin offering for all Israel, twelve male goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel. ¹⁸They set the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their courses, for the service of God which is at Jerusalem, as it is written in the book of Moses. ¹⁹The children of the captivity kept the Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month. ²⁰Because the priests and the Levites had purified themselves together, all of them were pure. They killed the Passover for all the children of the captivity, for their brothers the priests, and for themselves. ²¹The children of Israel who had returned out of the captivity, and all who had separated themselves to them from the filthiness of the nations of the land to seek the LORD, the God of Israel, ate, ²²and kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy; because the LORD had made them joyful, and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria to them, to strengthen their hands in the work of God, the God of Israel’s house.

⁷Now after these things, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah, ²the son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub, ³the son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth, ⁴the son of Zerahiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki, ⁵the son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest— ⁶this Ezra went up from Babylon. He was a skilled scribe in the

^{vii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Torah of Moses, which the LORD, the God of Israel, had given; and the king granted him all his request, according to the LORD his God's hand on him. ⁷Some of the children of Israel, including some of the priests, the Levites, the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants went up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king. ⁸He came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king. ⁹For on the first day of the first month he began to go up from Babylon; and on the first day of the fifth month he came to Jerusalem, according to the good hand of his God on him. ¹⁰For Ezra had set his heart to seek the LORD's law, and to do it, and to teach statutes and ordinances in Israel. ¹¹Now this is the copy of the letter that King Artaxerxes gave to Ezra the priest, the scribe, even the scribe of the words of the LORD's commandments, and of his statutes to Israel: ¹²Artaxerxes, king of kings, To Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the perfect God of heaven. Now ¹³I make a decree that all those of the people of Israel and their priests and the Levites in my realm, who intend of their own free will to go to Jerusalem, go with you. ¹⁴Because you are sent by the king and his seven counselors to inquire concerning Judah and Jerusalem, according to the law of your God which is in your hand, ¹⁵and to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counselors have freely offered to the God of Israel, whose habitation is in Jerusalem, ¹⁶and all the silver and gold that you will find in all the province of Babylon, with the free will offering of the people and of the priests, offering willingly for the house of their God which is in Jerusalem. ¹⁷Therefore you shall with all diligence buy with this money bulls, rams, and lambs with their meal offerings and their drink offerings, and shall offer them on the altar of the house of your God which is in Jerusalem. ¹⁸Whatever seems good to you and to your brothers to do with the rest of the silver and the gold, do that according to the will of your God. ¹⁹The vessels that are given to you for the service of the house of your God, deliver before the God of Jerusalem. ²⁰Whatever more will be needed for the house of your God, which you may have occasion to give, give it out of the king's treasure house. ²¹I, even I, Artaxerxes the king, make a decree to all the treasurers who are beyond the River, that whatever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, requires of you, it shall be done with all diligence, ²²up to one hundred talents ^{viii} of silver, and to one hundred cors ^{ix} of wheat, and to one hundred baths ^x of wine, and to one hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much. ²³Whatever is commanded by the God of heaven, let it be done exactly for the house of the God of heaven; for why should there be

wrath against the realm of the king and his sons? ²⁴Also we inform you that it shall not be lawful to impose tribute, custom, or toll on any of the priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, temple servants, or laborers of this house of God. ²⁵You, Ezra, according to the wisdom of your God that is in your hand, appoint magistrates and judges who may judge all the people who are beyond the River, who all know the laws of your God; and teach him who doesn't know them. ²⁶Whoever will not do the law of your God and the law of the king, let judgment be executed on him with all diligence, whether it is to death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment. ²⁷Blessed be the LORD, the God of our fathers, who has put such a thing as this in the king's heart, to beautify the LORD's house which is in Jerusalem; ²⁸and has extended loving kindness to me before the king and his counselors, and before all the king's mighty princes. I was strengthened according to the LORD my God's hand on me, and I gathered together chief men out of Israel to go up with me.

⁸Now these are the heads of their fathers' households, and this is the genealogy of those who went up with me from Babylon, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king: ²Of the sons of Phinehas, Gershom. Of the sons of Ithamar, Daniel. Of the sons of David, Hattush. ³Of the sons of Shecaniah, of the sons of Parosh, Zechariah; and with him were listed by genealogy of the males one hundred fifty. ⁴Of the sons of Pahathmoab, Eliehoenai the son of Zerahiah; and with him two hundred males. ⁵Of the sons of Shecaniah, the son of Jahaziel; and with him three hundred males. ⁶Of the sons of Adin, Ebed the son of Jonathan; and with him fifty males. ⁷Of the sons of Elam, Jeshaiiah the son of Athaliah; and with him seventy males. ⁸Of the sons of Shephatiah, Zebadiah the son of Michael; and with him eighty males. ⁹Of the sons of Joab, Obadiah the son of Jehiel; and with him two hundred eighteen males. ¹⁰Of the sons of Shelomith, the son of Josiphiah; and with him one hundred sixty males. ¹¹Of the sons of Bebai, Zechariah the son of Bebai; and with him twenty-eight males. ¹²Of the sons of Azgad, Yochanan the son of Hakkatan; and with him one hundred ten males. ¹³Of the sons of Adonikam, who were the last, their names are: Eliphelet, Jeuel, and Shemaiah; and with them sixty males. ¹⁴Of the sons of Bigvai, Uthai and Zabbud; and with them seventy males. ¹⁵I gathered them together to the river that runs to Ahava; and there we encamped three days. Then I looked around at the people and the priests, and found there were none of the sons of Levi. ¹⁶Then I sent for Eliezer, for Ariel, for Shemaiah, for Elnathan, for Jarib, for Elnathan, for Nathan, for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, chief men; also for Joiarib and for Elnathan, who were teachers. ¹⁷I sent them out to Iddo the chief at the place Casiphia; and I told them what they should tell Iddo and his brothers the temple servants at the place Casiphia, that they should bring

^{viii}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

^{ix}1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels.

^x1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters or 2.4 pecks. 100 baths would be about 2,100 liters.

to us ministers for the house of our God. ¹⁸According to the good hand of our God on us they brought us a man of discretion, of the sons of Mahli, the son of Levi, the son of Israel, namely Sherebiah, with his sons and his brothers, eighteen; ¹⁹and Hashabiah, and with him Jeshaiiah of the sons of Merari, his brothers and their sons, twenty; ²⁰and of the temple servants, whom David and the princes had given for the service of the Levites, two hundred twenty temple servants. All of them were mentioned by name. ²¹Then I proclaimed a fast there at the river Ahava, that we might humble ourselves before our God, to seek from him a straight way for us, for our little ones, and for all our possessions. ²²For I was ashamed to ask of the king a band of soldiers and horsemen to help us against the enemy on the way, because we had spoken to the king, saying, "The hand of our God is on all those who seek him, for good; but his power and his wrath is against all those who forsake him." ²³So we fasted and begged our God for this, and he granted our request. ²⁴Then I set apart twelve of the chiefs of the priests, even Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their brothers with them, ²⁵and weighed to them the silver, the gold, and the vessels, even the offering for the house of our God, which the king, his counselors, his princes, and all Israel there present, had offered. ²⁶I weighed into their hand six hundred fifty talents of silver, ^{xi} one hundred talents of silver vessels, one hundred talents of gold, ²⁷twenty bowls of gold weighing one thousand darics, ^{xii} and two vessels of fine bright bronze, precious as gold. ²⁸I said to them, "You are holy to the LORD, and the vessels are holy. The silver and the gold are a free will offering to the LORD, the God of your fathers. ²⁹Watch and keep them until you weigh them before the chiefs of the priests, the Levites, and the princes of the fathers' households of Israel at Jerusalem, in the rooms of the LORD's house." ³⁰So the priests and the Levites received the weight of the silver, the gold, and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem to the house of our God. ³¹Then we departed from the river Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month, to go to Jerusalem. The hand of our God was on us, and he delivered us from the hand of the enemy and the bandits by the way. ³²We came to Jerusalem, and stayed there three days. ³³On the fourth day the silver and the gold and the vessels were weighed in the house of our God into the hand of Meremoth the son of Uriah the priest; and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas; and with them were Jozabad the son of Yeshua, and Noadiah the son of Binnui, the Levites. ³⁴Everything was counted and weighed; and all the weight was written at that time. ³⁵The children of the captivity, who had come out of exile, offered burnt offerings to the God of Israel: twelve bulls for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, and twelve male goats for a sin offering. All

this was a burnt offering to the LORD. ³⁶They delivered the king's commissions to the king's local governors and to the governors beyond the River. So they supported the people and God's house.

⁹Now when these things were done, the princes came near to me, saying, "The people of Israel, the priests, and the Levites have not separated themselves from the peoples of the lands, following their abominations, even those of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites. ²For they have taken of their daughters for themselves and for their sons, so that the holy offspring have mixed themselves with the peoples of the lands. Yes, the hand of the princes and rulers has been chief in this trespass." ³When I heard this thing, I tore my garment and my robe, and pulled the hair out of my head and of my beard, and sat down confounded. ⁴Then everyone who trembled at the words of the God of Israel were assembled to me because of the trespass of the exiles; and I sat confounded until the evening offering. ⁵At the evening offering I rose up from my humiliation, even with my garment and my robe torn; and I fell on my knees, and spread out my hands to the LORD my God; ⁶and I said, "My God, I am ashamed and blush to lift up my face to you, my God, for our iniquities have increased over our head, and our guiltiness has grown up to the heavens. ⁷Since the days of our fathers we have been exceedingly guilty to this day; and for our iniquities we, our kings, and our priests have been delivered into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to captivity, to plunder, and to confusion of face, as it is this day. ⁸Now for a little moment grace has been shown from the LORD our God, to leave us a remnant to escape, and to give us a stake in his holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes, and revive us a little in our bondage. ⁹For we are bondservants; yet our God has not forsaken us in our bondage, but has extended loving kindness to us in the sight of the kings of Persia, to revive us, to set up the house of our God, and to repair its ruins, and to give us a wall in Judah and in Jerusalem. ¹⁰"Now, our God, what shall we say after this? For we have forsaken your commandments, ¹¹which you have commanded by your servants the prophets, saying, 'The land to which you go to possess is an unclean land through the uncleanness of the peoples of the lands, through their abominations, which have filled it from one end to another with their filthiness. ¹²Now therefore don't give your daughters to their sons. Don't take their daughters to your sons, nor seek their peace or their prosperity forever, that you may be strong and eat the good of the land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children forever.' ¹³"After all that has come on us for our evil deeds and for our great guilt, since you, our God, have punished us less than our iniquities deserve, and have given us such a remnant, ¹⁴shall we again break your com-

^{xi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

^{xii}a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

mandments, and join ourselves with the peoples that do these abominations? Wouldn't you be angry with us until you had consumed us, so that there would be no remnant, nor any to escape? ¹⁵LORD, the God of Israel, you are righteous; for we are left a remnant that has escaped, as it is today. Behold, ^{xiii} we are before you in our guiltiness; for no one can stand before you because of this."

¹⁰Now while Ezra prayed and made confession, weeping and casting himself down before God's house, there was gathered together to him out of Israel a very great assembly of men and women and children; for the people wept very bitterly. ²Shecaniah the son of Jehiel, one of the sons of Elam, answered Ezra, "We have trespassed against our God, and have married foreign women of the peoples of the land. Yet now there is hope for Israel concerning this thing. ³Now therefore let's make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives and those who are born of them, according to the counsel of my lord and of those who tremble at the commandment of our God. Let it be done according to the law. ⁴Arise, for the matter belongs to you and we are with you. Be courageous, and do it." ⁵Then Ezra arose, and made the chiefs of the priests, the Levites, and all Israel to swear that they would do according to this word. So they swore. ⁶Then Ezra rose up from before God's house, and went into the room of Jehohanan the son of Eliashib. When he came there, he didn't eat bread or drank water, for he mourned because of the trespass of the exiles. ⁷They made a proclamation throughout Judah and Jerusalem to all the children of the captivity, that they should gather themselves together to Jerusalem; ⁸and that whoever didn't come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his possessions should be forfeited, and he himself separated from the assembly of the captivity. ⁹Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered themselves together to Jerusalem within the three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month; and all the people sat in the wide place in front of God's house, trembling because of this matter, and because of the great rain. ¹⁰Ezra the priest stood up and said to them, "You have trespassed, and have married foreign women, increasing the guilt of Israel. ¹¹Now therefore make confession to the LORD, the God of your fathers and do his pleasure. Separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from the foreign women." ¹²Then all the assembly answered with a loud voice, "We must do as you have said concerning us. ¹³But the people are many, and it is a time of much rain, and we are not able to stand outside. This is not a work of one day or two, for we have greatly transgressed in this matter. ¹⁴Now let our princes be appointed for all the assembly, and let all those who are in our cities

who have married foreign women come at appointed times, and with them the elders of every city and its judges, until the fierce wrath of our God is turned from us, until this matter is resolved." ¹⁵Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahzeiah the son of Tikvah stood up against this; and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them. ¹⁶The children of the captivity did so. Ezra the priest, with certain heads of fathers' households, after their fathers' houses, and all of them by their names, were set apart; and they sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter. ¹⁷They finished with all the men who had married foreign women by the first day of the first month. ¹⁸Among the sons of the priests there were found who had married foreign women: of the sons of Yeshua, the son of Jozadak, and his brothers: Maaseiah, Eliezer, Jarib, and Gedaliah. ¹⁹They gave their hand that they would put away their wives; and being guilty, they offered a ram of the flock for their guilt. ²⁰Of the sons of Immer: Hanani and Zebadiah. ²¹Of the sons of Harim: Maaseiah, Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel, and Uziah. ²²Of the sons of Pashhur: Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel, Jozabad, and Elasa. ²³Of the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei, Kelaiah (also called Kelita), Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer. ²⁴Of the singers: Eliashib. Of the gatekeepers: Shallum, Telem, and Uri. ²⁵Of Israel: Of the sons of Parosh: Ramiah, Izziah, Malchijah, Mijamin, Eleazar, Malchijah, and Benaiah. ²⁶Of the sons of Elam: Mattaniah, Zechariah, Jehiel, Abdi, Jeremoth, and Elijah. ²⁷Of the sons of Zattu: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad, and Aziza. ²⁸Of the sons of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai. ²⁹Of the sons of Bani: Meshullam, Malluch, Adaiah, Jashub, Sheal, and Jeremoth. ³⁰Of the sons of Pahathmoab: Adna, Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezalel, Binnui, and Manasseh. ³¹Of the sons of Harim: Eliezer, Isshijah, Malchijah, Shemaiah, Shimeon, ³²Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah. ³³Of the sons of Hashum: Mattenai, Mattattah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei. ³⁴Of the sons of Bani: Maadai, Amram, Uel, ³⁵Benaiah, Bedeiah, Cheluhi, ³⁶Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib, ³⁷Mattaniah, Mattenai, Jaasu, ³⁸Bani, Binnui, Shimei, ³⁹Shelemiah, Nathan, Adaiah, ⁴⁰Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai, ⁴¹Azarel, Shelemiah, Shemariah, ⁴²Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph. ⁴³Of the sons of Nebo: Jeiel, Matithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Iddo, Joel, and Benaiah. ⁴⁴All these had taken foreign wives. Some of them had wives by whom they had children.

^{xiii}"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Nehemiah

¹The words of Nehemiah the son of Hacaliah. Now in the month Chislev, in the twentieth year, as I was in Susa the palace, ²Hanani, one of my brothers, came, he and certain men out of Judah; and I asked them about the Jews who had escaped, who were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem. ³They said to me, "The remnant who are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach. The wall of Jerusalem is also broken down, and its gates are burned with fire." ⁴When I heard these words, I sat down and wept, and mourned several days; and I fasted and prayed before the God ⁱ of heaven, ⁵and said, "I beg you, LORD, ⁱⁱ the God of heaven, the great and awesome God who keeps covenant and loving kindness with those who love him and keep his commandments, ⁶let your ear now be attentive and your eyes open, that you may listen to the prayer of your servant which I pray before you at this time, day and night, for the children of Israel your servants, while I confess the sins of the children of Israel which we have sinned against you. Yes, I and my father's house have sinned. ⁷We have dealt very corruptly against you, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the ordinances, which you commanded your servant Moses. ⁸"Remember, I beg you, the word that you commanded your servant Moses, saying, 'If you trespass, I will scatter you among the peoples; ⁹but if you return to me, and keep my commandments and do them, though your outcasts were in the uttermost part of the heavens, yet I will gather them from there, and will bring them to the place that I have chosen, to cause my name to dwell there.' ¹⁰"Now these are your servants and your people, whom you have redeemed by your great power and by your strong hand. ¹¹Lord, ⁱⁱⁱ I beg you, let your ear be attentive now to the prayer of your servant, and to the prayer of your servants who delight to fear your name; and please prosper your servant today, and grant him mercy in the sight of this man." Now I was cup bearer to the king.

²In the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, when wine was before him, I picked up the

ⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim).

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

wine, and gave it to the king. Now I had not been sad before in his presence. ²The king said to me, "Why is your face sad, since you are not sick? This is nothing else but sorrow of heart." Then I was very much afraid. ³I said to the king, "Let the king live forever! Why shouldn't my face be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' tombs, lies waste, and its gates have been consumed with fire?" ⁴Then the king said to me, "What is your request?" So I prayed to the God of heaven. ⁵I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, and if your servant has found favor in your sight, I ask that you would send me to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, that I may build it." ⁶The king said to me (the queen was also sitting by him), "How long will your journey be? When will you return?" So it pleased the king to send me, and I set a time for him. ⁷Moreover I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the River, that they may let me pass through until I come to Judah; ⁸and a letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the citadel by the temple, for the wall of the city, and for the house that I will occupy." The king granted my requests, because of the good hand of my God on me. ⁹Then I came to the governors beyond the River, and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had sent captains of the army and horsemen with me. ¹⁰When Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite servant heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly, because a man had come to seek the welfare of the children of Israel. ¹¹So I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days. ¹²I arose in the night, I and a few men with me. I didn't tell anyone what my God put into my heart to do for Jerusalem. There wasn't any animal with me except the animal that I rode on. ¹³I went out by night by the valley gate toward the jackal's well, then to the dung gate; and I inspected the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and its gates were consumed with fire. ¹⁴Then I went on to the spring gate and to the king's pool, but there was no place for the animal that was under me to pass. ¹⁵Then I went up in the night by the brook and inspected the wall; and I turned back, and entered by the valley gate, and so returned. ¹⁶The rulers didn't know where I went, or what I did. I had not as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest who

did the work. ¹⁷Then I said to them, “You see the bad situation that we are in, how Jerusalem lies waste, and its gates are burned with fire. Come, let’s build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we won’t be disgraced.” ¹⁸I told them about the hand of my God which was good on me, and also about the king’s words that he had spoken to me. They said, “Let’s rise up and build.” So they strengthened their hands for the good work. ¹⁹But when Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite servant, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they ridiculed us and despised us, and said, “What is this thing that you are doing? Will you rebel against the king?” ²⁰Then I answered them, and said to them, “The God of heaven will prosper us. Therefore we, his servants, will arise and build; but you have no portion, nor right, nor memorial in Jerusalem.”

³Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brothers the priests, and they built the sheep gate. They sanctified it, and set up its doors. They sanctified it even to the tower of Hammeah, to the tower of Hananel. ²Next to him the men of Jericho built. Next to them Zaccur the son of Imri built. ³The sons of Hassenaah built the fish gate. They laid its beams, and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars. ⁴Next to them, Meremoth the son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz made repairs. Next to them, Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabel made repairs. Next to them, Zadok the son of Baana made repairs. ⁵Next to them, the Tekoites made repairs; but their nobles didn’t put their necks to the Lord’s work. ⁶Joiada the son of Paseah and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah repaired the old gate. They laid its beams and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars. ⁷Next to them, Melatiah the Gibeonite and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon and of Mizpah, repaired the residence of the governor beyond the River. ⁸Next to him, Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, goldsmiths, made repairs. Next to him, Hananiah, one of the perfumers, made repairs, and they fortified Jerusalem even to the wide wall. ⁹Next to them, Rephaiah the son of Hur, the ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made repairs. ¹⁰Next to them, Jedaiah the son of Harumaph made repairs across from his house. Next to him, Hattush the son of Hashabneiah made repairs. ¹¹Malchijah the son of Harim and Hasshub the son of Pahathmoab repaired another portion and the tower of the furnaces. ¹²Next to him, Shallum the son of Hallohesh, the ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, he and his daughters made repairs. ¹³Hanun and the inhabitants of Zanoah repaired the valley gate. They built it, and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars, and one thousand cubits ^{iv} of the wall to the dung gate. ¹⁴Malchijah the son of Rechab, the ruler of the district of Beth Haccherem, repaired the dung gate. He built it, and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars. ¹⁵Shallun

the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of the district of Mizpah, repaired the spring gate. He built it, covered it, and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars; and he repaired the wall of the pool of Shelah by the king’s garden, even to the stairs that go down from David’s city. ¹⁶After him, Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, the ruler of half the district of Beth Zur, made repairs to the place opposite the tombs of David, and to the pool that was made, and to the house of the mighty men. ¹⁷After him, the Levites—Rehum the son of Bani made repairs. Next to him, Hashabiah, the ruler of half the district of Keilah, made repairs for his district. ¹⁸After him, their brothers, Bavvai the son of Henadad, the ruler of half the district of Keilah made repairs. ¹⁹Next to him, Ezer the son of Yeshua, the ruler of Mizpah, repaired another portion across from the ascent to the armory at the turning of the wall. ²⁰After him, Baruch the son of Zabbai earnestly repaired another portion, from the turning of the wall to the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest. ²¹After him, Meremoth the son of Uriah the son of Hakkoz repaired another portion, from the door of the house of Eliashib even to the end of the house of Eliashib. ²²After him, the priests, the men of the surrounding area made repairs. ²³After them, Benjamin and Hasshub made repairs across from their house. After them, Azariah the son of Maaseiah the son of Ananiah made repairs beside his own house. ²⁴After him, Binnui the son of Henadad repaired another portion, from the house of Azariah to the turning of the wall, and to the corner. ²⁵Palal the son of Uzai made repairs opposite the turning of the wall, and the tower that stands out from the upper house of the king, which is by the court of the guard. After him Pedaiah the son of Parosh made repairs. ²⁶(Now the temple servants lived in Ophel, to the place opposite the water gate toward the east, and the tower that stands out.) ²⁷After him the Tekoites repaired another portion, opposite the great tower that stands out, and to the wall of Ophel. ²⁸Above the horse gate, the priests made repairs, everyone across from his own house. ²⁹After them, Zadok the son of Immer made repairs across from his own house. After him, Shemaiah the son of Shecaniah, the keeper of the east gate, made repairs. ³⁰After him, Hananiah the son of Shelemiah, and Hanun, the sixth son of Zalaph, repaired another portion. After him, Meshullam the son of Berechiah made repairs across from his room. ³¹After him, Malchijah, one of the goldsmiths to the house of the temple servants, and of the merchants, made repairs opposite the gate of Hammiphkad and to the ascent of the corner. ³²Between the ascent of the corner and the sheep gate, the goldsmiths and the merchants made repairs.

⁴But when Sanballat heard that we were building the wall, he was angry, and was very indignant, and mocked the Jews. ²He spoke before his brothers and the army of Samaria, and said, “What are these feeble Jews doing?”

^{iv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Will they fortify themselves? Will they sacrifice? Will they finish in a day? Will they revive the stones out of the heaps of rubbish, since they are burned?" ³Now Tobiah the Ammonite was by him, and he said, "What they are building, if a fox climbed up it, he would break down their stone wall." ⁴"Hear, our God, for we are despised. Turn back their reproach on their own head. Give them up for a plunder in a land of captivity. ⁵Don't cover their iniquity. Don't let their sin be blotted out from before you; for they have insulted the builders." ⁶So we built the wall; and all the wall was joined together to half its height, for the people had a mind to work. ⁷But when Sanballat, Tobiah, the Arabians, the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites heard that the repairing of the walls of Jerusalem went forward, and that the breaches began to be filled, they were very angry; ⁸and they all conspired together to come and fight against Jerusalem, and to cause confusion among us. ⁹But we made our prayer to our God, and set a watch against them day and night because of them. ¹⁰Judah said, "The strength of the bearers of burdens is fading and there is much rubble, so that we are not able to build the wall." ¹¹Our adversaries said, "They will not know or see, until we come in among them and kill them, and cause the work to cease." ¹²When the Jews who lived by them came, they said to us ten times from all places, "Wherever you turn, they will attack us." ¹³Therefore I set guards in the lowest parts of the space behind the wall, in the open places. I set the people by family groups with their swords, their spears, and their bows. ¹⁴I looked, and rose up, and said to the nobles, to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, "Don't be afraid of them! Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome, and fight for your brothers, your sons, your daughters, your wives, and your houses." ¹⁵When our enemies heard that it was known to us, and God had brought their counsel to nothing, all of us returned to the wall, everyone to his work. ¹⁶From that time forth, half of my servants did the work, and half of them held the spears, the shields, the bows, and the coats of mail; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah. ¹⁷Those who built the wall, and those who bore burdens loaded themselves; everyone with one of his hands did the work, and with the other held his weapon. ¹⁸Among the builders, everyone wore his sword at his side, and so built. He who sounded the shofar was by me. ¹⁹I said to the nobles, and to the rulers and to the rest of the people, "The work is great and widely spread out, and we are separated on the wall, far from one another. ²⁰Wherever you hear the sound of the shofar, rally there to us. Our God will fight for us." ²¹So we did the work. Half of the people held the spears from the rising of the morning until the stars appeared. ²²Likewise at the same time I said to the people, "Let everyone with his servant lodge within Jerusalem, that in the night they may be a guard to us, and may labor in the day." ²³So neither I, nor my brothers, nor my servants, nor

the men of the guard who followed me took off our clothes. Everyone took his weapon to the water.

⁵Then there arose a great cry of the people and of their wives against their brothers the Jews. ²For there were some who said, "We, our sons and our daughters, are many. Let us get grain, that we may eat and live." ³There were also some who said, "We are mortgaging our fields, our vineyards, and our houses. Let us get grain, because of the famine." ⁴There were also some who said, "We have borrowed money for the king's tribute using our fields and our vineyards as collateral. ⁵Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brothers, our children as their children. Behold, ^v we bring our sons and our daughters into bondage to be servants, and some of our daughters have been brought into bondage. It is also not in our power to help it, because other men have our fields and our vineyards." ⁶I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words. ⁷Then I consulted with myself, and contended with the nobles and the rulers, and said to them, "You exact usury, everyone of his brother." I held a great assembly against them. ⁸I said to them, "We, after our ability, have redeemed our brothers the Jews that were sold to the nations; and would you even sell your brothers, and should they be sold to us?" Then they held their peace, and found not a word to say. ⁹Also I said, "The thing that you do is not good. Shouldn't you walk in the fear of our God because of the reproach of the nations, our enemies? ¹⁰I likewise, my brothers and my servants, lend them money and grain. Please let us stop this usury. ¹¹Please restore to them, even today, their fields, their vineyards, their olive groves, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, that you are charging them." ¹²Then they said, "We will restore them, and will require nothing of them. We will do so, even as you say." Then I called the priests, and took an oath of them, that they would do according to this promise. ¹³Also I shook out my lap, and said, "So may God shake out every man from his house, and from his labor, that doesn't perform this promise; even may he be shaken out and emptied like this." All the assembly said, "Amen," and praised the LORD. The people did according to this promise. ¹⁴Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even to the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelve years, I and my brothers have not eaten the bread of the governor. ¹⁵But the former governors who were before me were supported by the people, and took bread and wine from them, plus forty shekels ^{vi} of silver; yes, even their servants ruled over the people, but I didn't do so, because of the fear of God. ¹⁶Yes, I also

^v"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{vi}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

continued in the work of this wall. We didn't buy any land. All my servants were gathered there to the work. ¹⁷Moreover there were at my table, of the Jews and the rulers, one hundred fifty men, in addition to those who came to us from among the nations that were around us. ¹⁸Now that which was prepared for one day was one ox and six choice sheep. Also fowls were prepared for me, and once in ten days a store of all sorts of wine. Yet for all this, I didn't demand the governor's pay, because the bondage was heavy on this people. ¹⁹Remember me, my God, for all the good that I have done for this people.

⁶Now when it was reported to Sanballat, Tobiah, Geshem the Arabian, and to the rest of our enemies that I had built the wall, and that there was no breach left in it (though even to that time I had not set up the doors in the gates), ²Sanballat and Geshem sent to me, saying, "Come! Let's meet together in the villages in the plain of Ono." But they intended to harm me. ³I sent messengers to them, saying, "I am doing a great work, so that I can't come down. Why should the work cease while I leave it and come down to you?" ⁴They sent to me four times like this; and I answered them the same way. ⁵Then Sanballat sent his servant to me the same way the fifth time with an open letter in his hand, ⁶in which was written, "It is reported among the nations, and Gashmu says it, that you and the Jews intend to rebel. Because of that, you are building the wall. You would be their king, according to these words. ⁷You have also appointed prophets to proclaim of you at Jerusalem, saying, 'There is a king in Judah!' Now it will be reported to the king according to these words. Come now therefore, and let's take counsel together." ⁸Then I sent to him, saying, "There are no such things done as you say, but you imagine them out of your own heart." ⁹For they all would have made us afraid, saying, "Their hands will be weakened from the work, that it not be done." But now, strengthen my hands. ¹⁰I went to the house of She-maiah the son of Delaiah the son of Mehetabel, who was shut in at his home; and he said, "Let us meet together in God's house, within the temple, and let's shut the doors of the temple; for they will come to kill you. Yes, in the night they will come to kill you." ¹¹I said, "Should a man like me flee? Who is there that, being such as I, would go into the temple to save his life? I will not go in." ¹²I discerned, and behold, God had not sent him, but he pronounced this prophecy against me. Tobiah and Sanballat had hired him. ¹³He was hired so that I would be afraid, do so, and sin, and that they might have material for an evil report, that they might reproach me. ¹⁴"Remember, my God, Tobiah and Sanballat according to these their works, and also the prophetess Noadiah and the rest of the prophets that would have put me in fear." ¹⁵So the wall was finished in the twenty-fifth day of Elul, in fifty-two days. ¹⁶When all our enemies heard of it, all the nations that were around

us were afraid, and they lost their confidence; for they perceived that this work was done by our God. ¹⁷Moreover in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters to Tobiah, and Tobiah's letters came to them. ¹⁸For there were many in Judah sworn to him because he was the son-in-law of Shecaniah the son of Arah; and his son Jehohanan had taken the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah as wife. ¹⁹Also they spoke of his good deeds before me, and reported my words to him. Tobiah sent letters to put me in fear.

⁷Now when the wall was built and I had set up the doors, and the gatekeepers and the singers and the Levites were appointed, ²I put my brother Hanani, and Hananiah the governor of the fortress, in charge of Jerusalem; for he was a faithful man and feared God above many. ³I said to them, "Don't let the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun is hot; and while they stand guard, let them shut the doors, and you bar them; and appoint watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, everyone in his watch, with everyone near his house." ⁴Now the city was wide and large; but the people were few therein, and the houses were not built. ⁵My God put into my heart to gather together the nobles, and the rulers, and the people, that they might be listed by genealogy. I found the book of the genealogy of those who came up at the first, and I found this written in it: ⁶These are the children of the province who went up out of the captivity of those who had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away, and who returned to Jerusalem and to Judah, everyone to his city, ⁷who came with Zerubbabel, Yeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, and Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel: ⁸The children of Parosh: two thousand one hundred seventy-two. ⁹The children of Shephatiah: three hundred seventy-two. ¹⁰The children of Arah: six hundred fifty-two. ¹¹The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Yeshua and Joab: two thousand eight hundred eighteen. ¹²The children of Elam: one thousand two hundred fifty-four. ¹³The children of Zattu: eight hundred forty-five. ¹⁴The children of Zaccai: seven hundred sixty. ¹⁵The children of Binnui: six hundred forty-eight. ¹⁶The children of Bebai: six hundred twenty-eight. ¹⁷The children of Azgad: two thousand three hundred twenty-two. ¹⁸The children of Adonikam: six hundred sixty-seven. ¹⁹The children of Bigvai: two thousand sixty-seven. ²⁰The children of Adin: six hundred fifty-five. ²¹The children of Ater: of Hezekiah, ninety-eight. ²²The children of Hashum: three hundred twenty-eight. ²³The children of Bezai: three hundred twenty-four. ²⁴The children of Hariph: one hundred twelve. ²⁵The children of Gibeon: ninety-five. ²⁶The men of Bethlehem and Netophah: one hundred eighty-eight. ²⁷The men of Anathoth: one hundred twenty-eight. ²⁸The men of Beth

Azmaveth: forty-two. ²⁹The men of Kiriath Jearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth: seven hundred forty-three. ³⁰The men of Ramah and Geba: six hundred twenty-one. ³¹The men of Michmas: one hundred twenty-two. ³²The men of Bethel and Ai: one hundred twenty-three. ³³The men of the other Nebo: fifty-two. ³⁴The children of the other Elam: one thousand two hundred fifty-four. ³⁵The children of Harim: three hundred twenty. ³⁶The children of Jericho: three hundred forty-five. ³⁷The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono: seven hundred twenty-one. ³⁸The children of Senaah: three thousand nine hundred thirty. ³⁹The priests: The children of Jedaiah, of the house of Yeshua: nine hundred seventy-three. ⁴⁰The children of Immer: one thousand fifty-two. ⁴¹The children of Pashhur: one thousand two hundred forty-seven. ⁴²The children of Harim: one thousand seventeen. ⁴³The Levites: the children of Yeshua, of Kadmiel, of the children of Hodevah: seventy-four. ⁴⁴The singers: the children of Asaph: one hundred forty-eight. ⁴⁵The gatekeepers: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai: one hundred thirty-eight. ⁴⁶The temple servants: the children of Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the children of Tabbaoth, ⁴⁷the children of Keros, the children of Sia, the children of Padon, ⁴⁸the children of Lebana, the children of Hagaba, the children of Salmai, ⁴⁹the children of Hanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Gahar, ⁵⁰the children of Reaiah, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda, ⁵¹the children of Gazzam, the children of Uzza, the children of Paseah, ⁵²the children of Besai, the children of Meunim, the children of Nephushesim, ⁵³the children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur, ⁵⁴the children of Bazlith, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha, ⁵⁵the children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Temah, ⁵⁶the children of Nezhiah, and the children of Hatipha. ⁵⁷The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida, ⁵⁸the children of Jaala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel, ⁵⁹the children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth Hazzebaim, and the children of Amon. ⁶⁰All the temple servants and the children of Solomon's servants were three hundred ninety-two. ⁶¹These were those who went up from Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer; but they could not show their fathers' houses, nor their offspring, ^{vii} whether they were of Israel: ⁶²The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda: six hundred forty-two. ⁶³Of the priests: the children of Hobaiah, the children of Hakkoz, the children of Barzillai, who took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name. ⁶⁴These searched for their genealogical records, but couldn't find them. Therefore they were deemed disqualified and re-

^{vii}or, seed

moved from the priesthood. ⁶⁵The governor told them not to eat of the most holy things until a priest stood up to minister with Urim and Thummim. ⁶⁶The whole assembly together was forty-two thousand three hundred sixty, ⁶⁷in addition to their male servants and their female servants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven. They had two hundred forty-five singing men and singing women. ⁶⁸Their horses were seven hundred thirty-six; their mules, two hundred forty-five; ⁶⁹their camels, four hundred thirty-five; their donkeys, six thousand seven hundred twenty. ⁷⁰Some from among the heads of fathers' households gave to the work. The governor gave to the treasury one thousand darics of gold, ^{viii} fifty basins, and five hundred thirty priests' garments. ⁷¹Some of the heads of fathers' households gave into the treasury of the work twenty thousand darics of gold, and two thousand two hundred minas ^{ix} of silver. ⁷²That which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand darics of gold, plus two thousand minas of silver, and sixty-seven priests' garments. ⁷³So the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers, some of the people, the temple servants, and all Israel lived in their cities. When the seventh month had come, the children of Israel were in their cities.

8All the people gathered themselves together as one man into the wide place that was in front of the water gate; and they spoke to Ezra the scribe to bring the scroll of the Torah of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel. ²Ezra the priest brought the law before the assembly, both men and women, and all who could hear with understanding, on the first day of the seventh month. ³He read from it before the wide place that was in front of the water gate from early morning until midday, in the presence of the men and the women, and of those who could understand. The ears of all the people were attentive to the scroll of the Torah. ⁴Ezra the scribe stood on a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose; and beside him stood Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand; and on his left hand, Pedaiah, Mishael, Malchijah, Hashum, Hashbaddanah, Zechariah, and Meshullam. ⁵Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people (for he was above all the people), and when he opened it, all the people stood up. ⁶Then Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God. All the people answered, "Amen, Amen," with the lifting up of their hands. They bowed their heads, and worshiped the LORD with their faces to the ground. ⁷Also Yeshua, Bani, Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the Levites, caused the people to understand the law; and the people

^{viii}a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

^{ix}A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds, so 2,200 minas is about 1.3 metric tons.

stayed in their place. ⁸They read in the book, in the law of God, distinctly; and they gave the sense, so that they understood the reading. ⁹Nehemiah, who was the governor, Ezra the priest and scribe, and the Levites who taught the people said to all the people, "Today is holy to the LORD your God. Don't mourn, nor weep." For all the people wept when they heard the words of the law. ¹⁰Then he said to them, "Go your way. Eat the fat, drink the sweet, and send portions to him for whom nothing is prepared, for today is holy to our Lord. Don't be grieved, for the joy of the LORD is your strength." ¹¹So the Levites calmed all the people, saying, "Hold your peace, for the day is holy. Don't be grieved." ¹²All the people went their way to eat, to drink, to send portions, and to celebrate, because they had understood the words that were declared to them. ¹³On the second day, the heads of fathers' households of all the people, the priests, and the Levites were gathered together to Ezra the scribe, to study the words of the law. ¹⁴They found written in the Torah how the LORD had commanded by Moses that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month; ¹⁵and that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities and in Jerusalem, saying, "Go out to the mountain, and get olive branches, branches of wild olive, myrtle branches, palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make temporary shelters, ^x as it is written." ¹⁶So the people went out and brought them, and made themselves temporary shelters, ^{xi} everyone on the roof of his house, in their courts, in the courts of God's house, in the wide place of the water gate, and in the wide place of Ephraim's gate. ¹⁷All the assembly of those who had come back out of the captivity made temporary shelters ^{xii} and lived in the temporary shelters, for since the days of Joshua the son of Nun to that day the children of Israel had not done so. There was very great gladness. ¹⁸Also day by day, from the first day to the last day, he read in the scroll of the Torah of God. They kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day was a solemn assembly, according to the ordinance.

⁹Now in the twenty-fourth day of this month the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, with sackcloth, and dirt on them. ²The offspring of Israel separated themselves from all foreigners and stood and confessed their sins and the iniquities of their fathers. ³They stood up in their place, and read in the scroll of the Torah of the LORD their God a fourth part of the day; and a fourth part they confessed and worshiped the LORD their God. ⁴Then Yeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani of the Levites stood up on the stairs, and cried with a loud voice to the LORD their God. ⁵Then the Levites, Yeshua, and Kadmiel, Bani, Hashab-

nehiah, Sherebiah, Hodiah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, said, "Stand up and bless the LORD your God from everlasting to everlasting! Blessed be your glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise! ⁶You are the LORD, even you alone. You have made heaven, the heaven of heavens, with all their army, the earth and all things that are on it, the seas and all that is in them, and you preserve them all. The army of heaven worships you. ⁷You are the LORD, the God who chose Abram, brought him out of Ur-Kasdim, gave him the name of Abraham, ⁸found his heart faithful before you, and made a covenant with him to give the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite, and the Girgashite, to give it to his offspring, and have performed your words, for you are righteous. ⁹"You saw the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and heard their cry by the Sea of Suf, ¹⁰and showed signs and wonders against Pharaoh, against all his servants, and against all the people of his land, for you knew that they dealt proudly against them, and made a name for yourself, as it is today. ¹¹You divided the sea before them, so that they went through the middle of the sea on the dry land; and you cast their pursuers into the depths, as a stone into the mighty waters. ¹²Moreover, in a pillar of cloud you led them by day; and in a pillar of fire by night, to give them light in the way in which they should go. ¹³"You also came down on Mount Sinai, and spoke with them from heaven, and gave them right ordinances and true laws, good statutes and commandments, ¹⁴and made known to them your holy Sabbath, and commanded them commandments, statutes, and a law, by Moses your servant, ¹⁵and gave them bread from the sky for their hunger, and brought water out of the rock for them for their thirst, and commanded them that they should go in to possess the land which you had sworn to give them. ¹⁶"But they and our fathers behaved proudly, hardened their neck, didn't listen to your commandments, ¹⁷and refused to obey. They weren't mindful of your wonders that you did among them, but hardened their neck, and in their rebellion appointed a captain to return to their bondage. But you are a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, and didn't forsake them. ¹⁸Yes, when they had made themselves a molded calf, and said, 'This is your God who brought you up out of Egypt,' and had committed awful blasphemies, ¹⁹yet you in your manifold mercies didn't forsake them in the wilderness. The pillar of cloud didn't depart from over them by day, to lead them in the way; neither did the pillar of fire by night, to show them light, and the way in which they should go. ²⁰You gave also your good Spirit to instruct them, and didn't withhold your manna from their mouth, and gave them water for their thirst. ²¹"Yes, forty years you sustained them in the wilderness. They lacked nothing. Their clothes didn't grow old, and their feet didn't swell. ²²Moreover you gave them kingdoms and

^xor, booths

^{xi}or, booths

^{xii}or, booths

peoples, which you allotted according to their portions. So they possessed the land of Sihon, even the land of the king of Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan. ²³You also multiplied their children as the stars of the sky, and brought them into the land concerning which you said to their fathers that they should go in to possess it. ²⁴“So the children went in and possessed the land; and you subdued before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gave them into their hands, with their kings and the peoples of the land, that they might do with them as they pleased. ²⁵They took fortified cities and a rich land, and possessed houses full of all good things, cisterns dug out, vineyards, olive groves, and fruit trees in abundance. So they ate, were filled, became fat, and delighted themselves in your great goodness. ²⁶“Nevertheless they were disobedient and rebelled against you, cast your law behind their back, killed your prophets that testified against them to turn them again to you, and they committed awful blasphemies. ²⁷Therefore you delivered them into the hand of their adversaries, who distressed them. In the time of their trouble, when they cried to you, you heard from heaven; and according to your manifold mercies you gave them saviors who saved them out of the hands of their adversaries. ²⁸But after they had rest, they did evil again before you; therefore you left them in the hands of their enemies, so that they had the dominion over them; yet when they returned and cried to you, you heard from heaven; and many times you delivered them according to your mercies, ²⁹and testified against them, that you might bring them again to your law. Yet they were arrogant, and didn’t listen to your commandments, but sinned against your ordinances (which if a man does, he shall live in them), turned their backs, stiffened their neck, and would not hear. ³⁰Yet many years you put up with them, and testified against them by your Spirit through your prophets. Yet they would not listen. Therefore you gave them into the hand of the peoples of the lands. ³¹“Nevertheless in your manifold mercies you didn’t make a full end of them, nor forsake them; for you are a gracious and merciful God. ³²Now therefore, our God, the great, the mighty, and the awesome God, who keeps covenant and loving kindness, don’t let all the travail seem little before you that has come on us, on our kings, on our princes, on our priests, on our prophets, on our fathers, and on all your people, since the time of the kings of Assyria to this day. ³³However you are just in all that has come on us; for you have dealt truly, but we have done wickedly. ³⁴Also our kings, our princes, our priests, and our fathers have not kept your law, nor listened to your commandments and your testimonies with which you testified against them. ³⁵For they have not served you in their kingdom, and in your great goodness that you gave them, and in the large and rich land which you gave before them. They didn’t turn from their wicked works. ³⁶“Behold, we are servants today, and as for the

land that you gave to our fathers to eat its fruit and its good, behold, we are servants in it. ³⁷It yields much increase to the kings whom you have set over us because of our sins. Also they have power over our bodies and over our livestock, at their pleasure, and we are in great distress. ³⁸Yet for all this, we make a sure covenant, and write it; and our princes, our Levites, and our priests, seal it.”

10Now those who sealed were: Nehemiah the governor, the son of Hacaliah, and Zedekiah, ²Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah, ³Pashhur, Amariah, Malchijah, ⁴Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch, ⁵Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah, ⁶Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch, ⁷Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin, ⁸Maaziah, Bilgai, and Shemaiah. These were the priests. ⁹The Levites: Yeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel; ¹⁰and their brothers, Shebaniah, Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan, ¹¹Mica, Rehob, Hashabiah, ¹²Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah, ¹³Hodiah, Bani, and Beninu. ¹⁴The chiefs of the people: Parosh, Pahathmoab, Elam, Zattu, Bani, ¹⁵Bunni, Azgad, Bebai, ¹⁶Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin, ¹⁷Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur, ¹⁸Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai, ¹⁹Hariph, Anathoth, Nobai, ²⁰Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir, ²¹Meshezabel, Zadok, Jaddua, ²²Pelathiah, Hanan, Ananiah, ²³Hoshea, Hananiah, Hasshub, ²⁴Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek, ²⁵Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah, ²⁶Ahiah, Hanan, Anan, ²⁷Malluch, Harim, and Baanah. ²⁸The rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers, the temple servants, and all those who had separated themselves from the peoples of the lands to the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters—everyone who had knowledge and understanding—²⁹joined with their brothers, their nobles, and entered into a curse and into an oath, to walk in God’s Torah, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our Lord, and his ordinances and his statutes; ³⁰and that we would not give our daughters to the peoples of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons; ³¹and if the peoples of the land bring wares or any grain on the Sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy from them on the Sabbath, or on a holy day; and that we would forego the seventh year crops and the exaction of every debt. ³²Also we made ordinances for ourselves, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel ^{xiii} for the service of the house of our God: ³³for the show bread, for the continual meal offering, for the continual burnt offering, for the Sabbaths, for the new moons, for the set feasts, for the holy things, for the sin offerings to make atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our God. ³⁴We, the priests, the Levites, and the people, cast lots for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, according to our fathers’ houses, at times appointed year by year, to burn on the LORD our God’s altar, as it is written in the Torah; ³⁵and to bring the first fruits of our ground and the first fruits of

^{xiii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

all fruit of all kinds of trees, year by year, to the LORD's house; ³⁶also the firstborn of our sons and of our livestock, as it is written in the Torah, and the firstborn of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, to the priests who minister in the house of our God; ³⁷and that we should bring the first fruits of our dough, our wave offerings, the fruit of all kinds of trees, and the new wine and the oil, to the priests, to the rooms of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground to the Levites; for they, the Levites, take the tithes in all our farming villages. ³⁸The priest, the descendent of Aaron, shall be with the Levites when the Levites take tithes. The Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes to the house of our God, to the rooms, into the treasure house. ³⁹For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the wave offering of the grain, of the new wine, and of the oil, to the rooms where the vessels of the sanctuary are, and the priests who minister, with the gatekeepers and the singers. We will not forsake the house of our God.

11The princes of the people lived in Jerusalem. The rest of the people also cast lots to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem, the holy city, and nine parts in the other cities. ²The people blessed all the men who willingly offered themselves to dwell in Jerusalem. ³Now these are the chiefs of the province who lived in Jerusalem; but in the cities of Judah, everyone lived in his possession in their cities—Israel, the priests, the Levites, the temple servants, and the children of Solomon's servants. ⁴Some of the children of Judah and of the children of Benjamin lived in Jerusalem. Of the children of Judah: Athaiah the son of Uziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalalel, of the children of Perez; ⁵and Maaseiah the son of Baruch, the son of Colhozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the son of the Shilonite. ⁶All the sons of Perez who lived in Jerusalem were four hundred sixty-eight valiant men. ⁷These are the sons of Benjamin: Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jeshaiiah. ⁸After him Gabbai and Salalai, nine hundred twenty-eight. ⁹Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer; and Judah the son of Hassenuah was second over the city. ¹⁰Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin, ¹¹Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the ruler of God's house, ¹²and their brothers who did the work of the house, eight hundred twenty-two; and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashhur, the son of Malchijah, ¹³and his brothers, chiefs of fathers' households, two hundred forty-two; and Amashsai the son of Azarel, the son of Ahzai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer, ¹⁴and their brothers, mighty men of valor,

one hundred twenty-eight; and their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of Haggadolim. ¹⁵Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni; ¹⁶and Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the chiefs of the Levites, who had the oversight of the outward business of God's house; ¹⁷and Mattaniah the son of Mica, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, who was the chief to begin the thanksgiving in prayer, and Bakbukiah, the second among his brothers; and Abda the son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun. ¹⁸All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred eighty-four. ¹⁹Moreover the gatekeepers, Akkub, Talmon, and their brothers, who kept watch at the gates, were one hundred seventy-two. ²⁰The residue of Israel, of the priests, and the Levites were in all the cities of Judah, everyone in his inheritance. ²¹But the temple servants lived in Ophel; and Ziha and Gishpa were over the temple servants. ²²The overseer also of the Levites at Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Mica, of the sons of Asaph, the singers, was over the business of God's house. ²³For there was a commandment from the king concerning them, and a settled provision for the singers, as every day required. ²⁴Pethahiah the son of Meshezabel, of the children of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's hand in all matters concerning the people. ²⁵As for the villages with their fields, some of the children of Judah lived in Kiriath Arba and its towns, in Dibon and its towns, in Jekabzeel and its villages, ²⁶in Yeshua, in Moladah, Beth Pelet, ²⁷in Hazar Shual, in Beersheba and its towns, ²⁸in Ziklag, in Meconah and in its towns, ²⁹in En Rimmon, in Zorah, in Jarmuth, ³⁰Zanoah, Adullam, and their villages, Lachish and its fields, and Azekah and its towns. So they encamped from Beersheba to the valley of Hinnom. ³¹The children of Benjamin also lived from Geba onward, at Michmash and Aija, and at Bethel and its towns, ³²at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah, ³³Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim, ³⁴Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat, ³⁵Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen. ³⁶Of the Levites, certain divisions in Judah settled in Benjamin's territory.

12Now these are the priests and the Levites who went up with Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Yeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra, ²Amariah, Malluch, Hattush, ³Shecaniah, Rehum, Meremoth, ⁴Iddo, Ginnethoi, Abijah, ⁵Mijamin, Maadiah, Bilgah, ⁶Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah, ⁷Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, and Jedaiah. These were the chiefs of the priests and of their brothers in the days of Yeshua. ⁸Moreover the Levites were Yeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and Mattaniah, who was over the thanksgiving songs, he and his brothers. ⁹Also Bakbukiah and Unno, their brothers, were close to them according to their offices. ¹⁰Yeshua became the father of Joiakim, and Joiakim became the father of Eliashib, and Eliashib became the father of Joiada, ¹¹and Joiada became the father of Jonathan, and Jonathan

became the father of Jaddua. ¹²In the days of Joiakim were priests, heads of fathers' households: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah; ¹³of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan; ¹⁴of Malluchi, Jonathan; of Shebaniah, Joseph; ¹⁵of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai; ¹⁶of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam; ¹⁷of Abijah, Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah, Piltai; ¹⁸of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah, Jehonathan; ¹⁹of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi; ²⁰of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber; ²¹of Hilkiah, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah, Nethanel. ²²As for the Levites, in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, Yochanan, and Jaddua, there were recorded the heads of fathers' households; also the priests, in the reign of Darius the Persian. ²³The sons of Levi, heads of fathers' households, were written in the book of the chronicles, even until the days of Yochanan the son of Eliashib. ²⁴The chiefs of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Yeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brothers close to them, to praise and give thanks according to the commandment of David the man of God, section next to section. ²⁵Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, and Akkub were gatekeepers keeping the watch at the storehouses of the gates. ²⁶These were in the days of Joiakim the son of Yeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor, and of Ezra the priest and scribe. ²⁷At the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem, they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem to keep the dedication with gladness, both with giving thanks and with singing, with cymbals, stringed instruments, and with harps. ²⁸The sons of the singers gathered themselves together, both out of the plain around Jerusalem and from the villages of the Netophathites; ²⁹also from Beth Gilgal and out of the fields of Geba and Azmaveth, for the singers had built themselves villages around Jerusalem. ³⁰The priests and the Levites purified themselves; and they purified the people, the gates, and the wall. ³¹Then I brought the princes of Judah up on the wall, and appointed two great companies who gave thanks and went in procession. One went on the right hand on the wall toward the dung gate; ³²and after them went Hoshaiiah, with half of the princes of Judah, ³³and Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam, ³⁴Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah, Jeremiah, ³⁵and some of the priests' sons with shofars ^{xiv} : or, trumpets Zechariah the son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph; ³⁶and his brothers, Shemaiah, Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah, and Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God; and Ezra the scribe was before them. ³⁷By the spring gate, and straight before them, they went up by the stairs of David's city, at the ascent of the wall, above David's house, even to the water gate eastward. ³⁸The other company of those who gave thanks went to meet them, and I after them, with the half of the people on the

wall above the tower of the furnaces, even to the wide wall, ³⁹and above the gate of Ephraim, and by the old gate, and by the fish gate, the tower of Hananel, and the tower of Hammeah, even to the sheep gate; and they stood still in the gate of the guard. ⁴⁰So the two companies of those who gave thanks in God's house stood, and I and the half of the rulers with me; ⁴¹and the priests, Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with shofars ^{xv} ; trumpets ⁴²and Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malchijah, Elam, and Ezer. The singers sang loud, with Jezrahiah their overseer. ⁴³They offered great sacrifices that day, and rejoiced, for God had made them rejoice with great joy; and the women and the children also rejoiced, so that the joy of Jerusalem was heard even far away. ⁴⁴On that day, men were appointed over the rooms for the treasures, for the wave offerings, for the first fruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them according to the fields of the cities the portions appointed by the law for the priests and Levites; for Judah rejoiced for the priests and for the Levites who served. ⁴⁵They performed the duty of their God and the duty of the purification, and so did the singers and the gatekeepers, according to the commandment of David and of Solomon his son. ⁴⁶For in the days of David and Asaph of old there was a chief of the singers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving to God. ⁴⁷All Israel in the days of Zerubbabel and in the days of Nehemiah gave the portions of the singers and the gatekeepers, as every day required; and they set apart that which was for the Levites; and the Levites set apart that which was for the sons of Aaron.

13On that day they read in the book of Moses in the hearing of the people; and it was found written in it that an Ammonite and a Moabite should not enter into the assembly of God forever, ²because they didn't meet the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them to curse them; however, our God turned the curse into a blessing. ³It came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated all the mixed multitude from Israel. ⁴Now before this, Eliashib the priest, who was appointed over the rooms of the house of our God, being allied to Tobiah, ⁵had prepared for him a great room, where before they laid the meal offerings, the frankincense, the vessels, and the tithes of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, which were given by commandment to the Levites, the singers, and the gatekeepers; and the wave offerings for the priests. ⁶But in all this, I was not at Jerusalem; for in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I went to the king; and after some days I asked leave of the king, ⁷and I came to Jerusalem, and understood the evil that Eliashib had done for Tobiah, in preparing him a room in the courts of God's house. ⁸It grieved me severely. Therefore I threw all Tobiah's household stuff out of the

^{xiv}or, trumpets:

^{xv}trumpets;

room. ⁹Then I commanded, and they cleansed the rooms. I brought into them the vessels of God's house, with the meal offerings and the frankincense again. ¹⁰I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them, so that the Levites and the singers, who did the work, had each fled to his field. ¹¹Then I contended with the rulers, and said, "Why is God's house forsaken?" I gathered them together, and set them in their place. ¹²Then all Judah brought the tithe of the grain, the new wine, and the oil to the treasuries. ¹³I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah; for they were counted faithful, and their business was to distribute to their brothers. ¹⁴Remember me, my God, concerning this, and don't wipe out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for its observances. ¹⁵In those days I saw some men treading wine presses on the Sabbath in Judah, bringing in sheaves, and loading donkeys with wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of burdens which they brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day; and I testified against them in the day in which they sold food. ¹⁶Some men of Tyre also lived there, who brought in fish and all kinds of wares, and sold on the Sabbath to the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem. ¹⁷Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said to them, "What evil thing is this that you do, and profane the Sabbath day? ¹⁸Didn't your fathers do this, and didn't our God bring all this evil on us and on this city? Yet you bring more wrath on Israel by profaning the Sabbath." ¹⁹It came to pass that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be shut, and commanded that they should not be opened until after the Sabbath. I set some of my servants over the gates, so that no burden should be brought in on the Sabbath day. ²⁰So the merchants and sellers of all kinds of wares camped outside of Jerusalem once or twice. ²¹Then I testified against them, and said to them, "Why do you stay around the wall? If you do so again, I will lay hands on you." From that time on, they didn't come on the Sabbath. ²²I commanded the Levites that they should purify themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the Sabbath day. Remember me for this also, my God, and spare me according to the greatness of your loving kindness. ²³In those days I also saw the Jews who had married women of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab; ²⁴and their children spoke half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people. ²⁵I contended with them, cursed them, struck certain of them, plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, "You shall not give your daughters to their sons, nor take their daughters for your sons, or for yourselves. ²⁶Didn't Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? Yet among many nations there was no king like him, and he was loved by his God,

and God made him king over all Israel. Nevertheless foreign women caused even him to sin. ²⁷Shall we then listen to you to do all this great evil, to trespass against our God in marrying foreign women?" ²⁸One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite; therefore I chased him from me. ²⁹Remember them, my God, because they have defiled the priesthood and the covenant of the priesthood and of the Levites. ³⁰Thus I cleansed them from all foreigners and appointed duties for the priests and for the Levites, everyone in his work; ³¹and for the wood offering, at appointed times, and for the first fruits. Remember me, my God, for good.

Esther

¹Now in the days of Ahasuerus (this is Ahasuerus who reigned from India even to Ethiopia, over one hundred twenty-seven provinces), ²in those days, when the King Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his kingdom, which was in Susa the palace, ³in the third year of his reign, he made a feast for all his princes and his servants; the army of Persia and Media, the nobles and princes of the provinces being before him. ⁴He displayed the riches of his glorious kingdom and the honor of his excellent majesty many days, even one hundred eighty days. ⁵When these days were fulfilled, the king made a seven day feast for all the people who were present in Susa the palace, both great and small, in the court of the garden of the king's palace. ⁶There were hangings of white and blue material, fastened with cords of fine linen and purple to silver rings and marble pillars. The couches were of gold and silver, on a pavement of red, white, yellow, and black marble. ⁷They gave them drinks in golden vessels of various kinds, including royal wine in abundance, according to the bounty of the king. ⁸In accordance with the law, the drinking was not compulsory; for so the king had instructed all the officials of his house, that they should do according to every man's pleasure. ⁹Also Vashti the queen made a feast for the women in the royal house which belonged to King Ahasuerus. ¹⁰On the seventh day, when the heart of the king was merry with wine, he commanded Mehuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Carcass, the seven eunuchs who served in the presence of Ahasuerus the king, ¹¹to bring Vashti the queen before the king wearing the royal crown, to show the people and the princes her beauty; for she was beautiful. ¹²But the queen Vashti refused to come at the king's commandment by the eunuchs. Therefore the king was very angry, and his anger burned in him. ¹³Then the king said to the wise men, who knew the times (for it was the king's custom to consult those who knew law and judgment; ¹⁴and next to him were Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshish, Meres, Marsena, and Memucan, the seven princes of Persia and Media, who saw the king's face, and sat first in the kingdom), ¹⁵"What shall we do to Queen Vashti according to law, because she has not done the bidding of the King Ahasuerus by the eunuchs?" ¹⁶Memucan answered before the king and the

princes, "Vashti the queen has not done wrong to just the king, but also to all the princes, and to all the people who are in all the provinces of the King Ahasuerus. ¹⁷For this deed of the queen will become known to all women, causing them to show contempt for their husbands when it is reported, 'King Ahasuerus commanded Vashti the queen to be brought in before him, but she didn't come.' ¹⁸Today, the princesses of Persia and Media who have heard of the queen's deed will tell all the king's princes. This will cause much contempt and wrath. ¹⁹"If it pleases the king, let a royal commandment go from him, and let it be written among the laws of the Persians and the Medes, so that it cannot be altered, that Vashti may never again come before King Ahasuerus; and let the king give her royal estate to another who is better than she. ²⁰When the king's decree which he shall make is published throughout all his kingdom (for it is great), all the wives will give their husbands honor, both great and small." ²¹This advice pleased the king and the princes, and the king did according to the word of Memucan: ²²for he sent letters into all the king's provinces, into every province according to its writing, and to every people in their language, that every man should rule his own house, speaking in the language of his own people.

²After these things, when the wrath of King Ahasuerus was pacified, he remembered Vashti, and what she had done, and what was decreed against her. ²Then the king's servants who served him said, "Let beautiful young virgins be sought for the king. ³Let the king appoint officers in all the provinces of his kingdom, that they may gather together all the beautiful young virgins to the citadel of Susa, to the women's house, to the custody of Hegai the king's eunuch, keeper of the women. Let cosmetics be given them; ⁴and let the maiden who pleases the king be queen instead of Vashti." The thing pleased the king, and he did so. ⁵There was a certain Jew in the citadel of Susa whose name was Mordecai, the son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, a Benjamite, ⁶who had been carried away from Jerusalem with the captives who had been carried away with Jeconiah king of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away. ⁷He brought up Hadassah, that is, Esther, his uncle's daugh-

ter; for she had neither father nor mother. The maiden was fair and beautiful; and when her father and mother were dead, Mordecai took her for his own daughter. ⁸So, when the king's commandment and his decree was heard, and when many maidens were gathered together to the citadel of Susa, to the custody of Hegai, Esther was taken into the king's house, to the custody of Hegai, keeper of the women. ⁹The maiden pleased him, and she obtained kindness from him. He quickly gave her cosmetics and her portions of food, and the seven choice maidens who were to be given her out of the king's house. He moved her and her maidens to the best place in the women's house. ¹⁰Esther had not made known her people nor her relatives, because Mordecai had instructed her that she should not make it known. ¹¹Mordecai walked every day in front of the court of the women's house, to find out how Esther was doing, and what would become of her. ¹²Each young woman's turn came to go in to King Ahasuerus after her purification for twelve months (for so were the days of their purification accomplished, six months with oil of myrrh, and six months with sweet fragrances and with preparations for beautifying women). ¹³The young woman then came to the king like this: whatever she desired was given her to go with her out of the women's house to the king's house. ¹⁴In the evening she went, and on the next day she returned into the second women's house, to the custody of Shaashgaz, the king's eunuch, who kept the concubines. She came in to the king no more, unless the king delighted in her, and she was called by name. ¹⁵Now when the turn of Esther, the daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai, who had taken her for his daughter, came to go in to the king, she required nothing but what Hegai the king's eunuch, the keeper of the women, advised. Esther obtained favor in the sight of all those who looked at her. ¹⁶So Esther was taken to King Ahasuerus into his royal house in the tenth month, which is the month Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign. ¹⁷The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti. ¹⁸Then the king made a great feast for all his princes and his servants, even Esther's feast; and he proclaimed a holiday in the provinces, and gave gifts according to the king's bounty. ¹⁹When the virgins were gathered together the second time, Mordecai was sitting in the king's gate. ²⁰Esther had not yet made known her relatives nor her people, as Mordecai had commanded her; for Esther obeyed Mordecai, like she did when she was brought up by him. ²¹In those days, while Mordecai was sitting in the king's gate, two of the king's eunuchs, Bigthan and Teresh, who were doorkeepers, were angry, and sought to lay hands on the King Ahasuerus. ²²This thing became known to Mordecai, who informed Esther the queen; and Esther informed the king in Mordecai's name. ²³When

this matter was investigated, and it was found to be so, they were both hanged on a gallows; and it was written in the book of the chronicles in the king's presence.

3After these things King Ahasuerus promoted Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, and advanced him, and set his seat above all the princes who were with him. ²All the king's servants who were in the king's gate bowed down and paid homage to Haman, for the king had so commanded concerning him. But Mordecai didn't bow down or pay him homage. ³Then the king's servants who were in the king's gate said to Mordecai, "Why do you disobey the king's commandment?" ⁴Now it came to pass, when they spoke daily to him, and he didn't listen to them, that they told Haman, to see whether Mordecai's reason would stand; for he had told them that he was a Jew. ⁵When Haman saw that Mordecai didn't bow down nor pay him homage, Haman was full of wrath. ⁶But he scorned the thought of laying hands on Mordecai alone, for they had made known to him Mordecai's people. Therefore Haman sought to destroy all the Jews who were throughout the whole kingdom of Ahasuerus, even Mordecai's people. ⁷In the first month, which is the month Nisan, in the twelfth year of King Ahasuerus, they cast Pur, that is, the lot, before Haman from day to day, and from month to month, and chose the twelfth month, which is the month Adar. ⁸Haman said to King Ahasuerus, "There is a certain people scattered abroad and dispersed among the peoples in all the provinces of your kingdom, and their laws are different from other people's. They don't keep the king's laws. Therefore it is not for the king's profit to allow them to remain. ⁹If it pleases the king, let it be written that they be destroyed; and I will pay ten thousand talents ⁱ of silver into the hands of those who are in charge of the king's business, to bring it into the king's treasuries." ¹⁰The king took his ring from his hand, and gave it to Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the Jews' enemy. ¹¹The king said to Haman, "The silver is given to you, the people also, to do with them as it seems good to you." ¹²Then the king's scribes were called in on the first month, on the thirteenth day of the month; and all that Haman commanded was written to the king's local governors, and to the governors who were over every province, and to the princes of every people, to every province according to its writing, and to every people in their language. It was written in the name of King Ahasuerus, and it was sealed with the king's ring. ¹³Letters were sent by couriers into all the king's provinces, to destroy, to kill, and to cause to perish, all Jews, both young and old, little children and women, in one day, even on the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is the month Adar, and to plunder their possessions. ¹⁴A copy of the letter, that the decree should be given out in every province, was published to all the peoples, that

ⁱA talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

they should be ready against that day. ¹⁵The couriers went out in haste by the king's commandment, and the decree was given out in the citadel of Susa. The king and Haman sat down to drink; but the city of Susa was perplexed.

⁴Now when Mordecai found out all that was done, Mordecai tore his clothes and put on sackcloth with ashes, and went out into the middle of the city, and wailed loudly and bitterly. ²He came even before the king's gate, for no one is allowed inside the king's gate clothed with sackcloth. ³In every province, wherever the king's commandment and his decree came, there was great mourning among the Jews, and fasting, and weeping, and wailing; and many lay in sackcloth and ashes. ⁴Esther's maidens and her eunuchs came and told her this, and the queen was exceedingly grieved. She sent clothing to Mordecai, to replace his sackcloth, but he didn't receive it. ⁵Then Esther called for Hathach, one of the king's eunuchs, whom he had appointed to attend her, and commanded him to go to Mordecai, to find out what this was, and why it was. ⁶So Hathach went out to Mordecai, to city square which was before the king's gate. ⁷Mordecai told him of all that had happened to him, and the exact sum of the money that Haman had promised to pay to the king's treasuries for the destruction of the Jews. ⁸He also gave him the copy of the writing of the decree that was given out in Susa to destroy them, to show it to Esther, and to declare it to her, and to urge her to go in to the king to make supplication to him, and to make request before him for her people. ⁹Hathach came and told Esther the words of Mordecai. ¹⁰Then Esther spoke to Hathach, and gave him a message to Mordecai: ¹¹"All the king's servants and the people of the king's provinces know that whoever, whether man or woman, comes to the king into the inner court without being called, there is one law for him, that he be put to death, except those to whom the king might hold out the golden scepter, that he may live. I have not been called to come in to the king these thirty days." ¹²They told Esther's words to Mordecai. ¹³Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: "Don't think to yourself that you will escape in the king's house any more than all the Jews. ¹⁴For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father's house will perish. Who knows if you haven't come to the kingdom for such a time as this?" ¹⁵Then Esther asked them to answer Mordecai, ¹⁶"Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and fast for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I and my maidens will also fast the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish." ¹⁷So Mordecai went his way, and did according to all that Esther had commanded him.

⁵Now on the third day, Esther put on her royal clothing

and stood in the inner court of the king's house, next to the king's house. The king sat on his royal throne in the royal house, next to the entrance of the house. ²When the king saw Esther the queen standing in the court, she obtained favor in his sight; and the king held out to Esther the golden scepter that was in his hand. So Esther came near and touched the top of the scepter. ³Then the king asked her, "What would you like, queen Esther? What is your request? It shall be given you even to the half of the kingdom." ⁴Esther said, "If it seems good to the king, let the king and Haman come today to the banquet that I have prepared for him." ⁵Then the king said, "Bring Haman quickly, so that it may be done as Esther has said." So the king and Haman came to the banquet that Esther had prepared. ⁶The king said to Esther at the banquet of wine, "What is your petition? It shall be granted you. What is your request? Even to the half of the kingdom it shall be performed." ⁷Then Esther answered and said, "My petition and my request is this. ⁸If I have found favor in the sight of the king, and if it pleases the king to grant my petition and to perform my request, let the king and Haman come to the banquet that I will prepare for them, and I will do tomorrow as the king has said." ⁹Then Haman went out that day joyful and glad of heart, but when Haman saw Mordecai in the king's gate, that he didn't stand up nor move for him, he was filled with wrath against Mordecai. ¹⁰Nevertheless Haman restrained himself, and went home. There, he sent and called for his friends and Zeresh his wife. ¹¹Haman recounted to them the glory of his riches, the multitude of his children, all the things in which the king had promoted him, and how he had advanced him above the princes and servants of the king. ¹²Haman also said, "Yes, Esther the queen let no man come in with the king to the banquet that she had prepared but myself; and tomorrow I am also invited by her together with the king. ¹³Yet all this avails me nothing, so long as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the king's gate." ¹⁴Then Zeresh his wife and all his friends said to him, "Let a gallows be made fifty cubits ⁱⁱ high, and in the morning speak to the king about hanging Mordecai on it. Then go in merrily with the king to the banquet." This pleased Haman, so he had the gallows made.

⁶On that night, the king couldn't sleep. He commanded the book of records of the chronicles to be brought, and they were read to the king. ²It was found written that Mordecai had told of Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king's eunuchs, who were doorkeepers, who had tried to lay hands on the King Ahasuerus. ³The king said, "What honor and dignity has been given to Mordecai for this?" Then the king's servants who attended him said, "Nothing has been done for him." ⁴The king said, "Who is in the

ⁱⁱA cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

court?" Now Haman had come into the outer court of the king's house, to speak to the king about hanging Mordecai on the gallows that he had prepared for him. ⁵The king's servants said to him, "Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ Haman stands in the court." The king said, "Let him come in." ⁶So Haman came in. The king said to him, "What shall be done to the man whom the king delights to honor?" Now Haman said in his heart, "Who would the king delight to honor more than myself?" ⁷Haman said to the king, "For the man whom the king delights to honor, ⁸let royal clothing be brought which the king uses to wear, and the horse that the king rides on, and on the head of which a royal crown is set. ⁹Let the clothing and the horse be delivered to the hand of one of the king's most noble princes, that they may array the man whom the king delights to honor with them, and have him ride on horseback through the city square, and proclaim before him, 'Thus it shall be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!'" ¹⁰Then the king said to Haman, "Hurry and take the clothing and the horse, as you have said, and do this for Mordecai the Jew, who sits at the king's gate. Let nothing fail of all that you have spoken." ¹¹Then Haman took the clothing and the horse, and arrayed Mordecai, and had him ride through the city square, and proclaimed before him, "Thus it shall be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!" ¹²Mordecai came back to the king's gate, but Haman hurried to his house, mourning and having his head covered. ¹³Haman recounted to Zeresh his wife and all his friends everything that had happened to him. Then his wise men and Zeresh his wife said to him, "If Mordecai, before whom you have begun to fall, is of Jewish descent, you will not prevail against him, but you will surely fall before him." ¹⁴While they were yet talking with him, the king's eunuchs came, and hurried to bring Haman to the banquet that Esther had prepared.

⁷So the king and Haman came to banquet with Esther the queen. ²The king said again to Esther on the second day at the banquet of wine, "What is your petition, queen Esther? It shall be granted you. What is your request? Even to the half of the kingdom it shall be performed." ³Then Esther the queen answered, "If I have found favor in your sight, O king, and if it pleases the king, let my life be given me at my petition, and my people at my request. ⁴For we are sold, I and my people, to be destroyed, to be slain, and to perish. But if we had been sold for male and female slaves, I would have held my peace, although the adversary could not have compensated for the king's loss." ⁵Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen, "Who is he, and where is he who dared presume in his heart to do so?" ⁶Esther said, "An adversary and an enemy, even this wicked Haman!" Then Haman was afraid before the

king and the queen. ⁷The king arose in his wrath from the banquet of wine and went into the palace garden. Haman stood up to make request for his life to Esther the queen, for he saw that there was evil determined against him by the king. ⁸Then the king returned out of the palace garden into the place of the banquet of wine; and Haman had fallen on the couch where Esther was. Then the king said, "Will he even assault the queen in front of me in the house?" As the word went out of the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face. ⁹Then Harbonah, one of the eunuchs who were with the king, said, "Behold, the gallows fifty cubits ^{iv} high, which Haman has made for Mordecai, who spoke good for the king, is standing at Haman's house." The king said, "Hang him on it!" ¹⁰So they hanged Haman on the gallows that he had prepared for Mordecai. Then the king's wrath was pacified.

⁸On that day, King Ahasuerus gave the house of Haman, the Jews' enemy, to Esther the queen. Mordecai came before the king; for Esther had told what he was to her. ²The king took off his ring, which he had taken from Haman, and gave it to Mordecai. Esther set Mordecai over the house of Haman. ³Esther spoke yet again before the king, and fell down at his feet and begged him with tears to put away the mischief of Haman the Agagite, and his plan that he had planned against the Jews. ⁴Then the king held out to Esther the golden scepter. So Esther arose, and stood before the king. ⁵She said, "If it pleases the king, and if I have found favor in his sight, and the thing seems right to the king, and I am pleasing in his eyes, let it be written to reverse the letters devised by Haman, the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, which he wrote to destroy the Jews who are in all the king's provinces. ⁶For how can I endure to see the evil that would come to my people? How can I endure to see the destruction of my relatives?" ⁷Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, "See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. ⁸Write also to the Jews as it pleases you, in the king's name, and seal it with the king's ring; for the writing which is written in the king's name, and sealed with the king's ring, may not be reversed by any man." ⁹Then the king's scribes were called at that time, in the third month, which is the month Sivan, on the twenty-third day of the month; and it was written according to all that Mordecai commanded to the Jews, and to the local governors, and the governors and princes of the provinces which are from India to Ethiopia, one hundred twenty-seven provinces, to every province according to its writing, and to every people in their language, and to the Jews in their writing, and in their language. ¹⁰He wrote in the name of King Ahasuerus, and sealed it with

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

the king's ring, and sent letters by courier on horseback, riding on royal horses that were bred from swift steeds. ¹¹In those letters, the king granted the Jews who were in every city to gather themselves together and to defend their lives—to destroy, to kill, and to cause to perish all the power of the people and province that would assault them, their little ones and women, and to plunder their possessions, ¹²on one day in all the provinces of King Ahasuerus, on the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is the month Adar. ¹³A copy of the letter, that the decree should be given out in every province, was published to all the peoples, that the Jews should be ready for that day to avenge themselves on their enemies. ¹⁴So the couriers who rode on royal horses went out, hastened and pressed on by the king's commandment. The decree was given out in the citadel of Susa. ¹⁵Mordecai went out of the presence of the king in royal clothing of blue and white, and with a great crown of gold, and with a robe of fine linen and purple; and the city of Susa shouted and was glad. ¹⁶The Jews had light, gladness, joy, and honor. ¹⁷In every province and in every city, wherever the king's commandment and his decree came, the Jews had gladness, joy, a feast and a holiday. Many from among the peoples of the land became Jews, for the fear of the Jews had fallen on them.

9Now in the twelfth month, which is the month Adar, on the thirteenth day of the month, when the king's commandment and his decree came near to be put in execution, on the day that the enemies of the Jews hoped to conquer them, (but it turned out that the opposite happened, that the Jews conquered those who hated them), ²the Jews gathered themselves together in their cities throughout all the provinces of the King Ahasuerus, to lay hands on those who wanted to harm them. No one could withstand them, because the fear of them had fallen on all the people. ³All the princes of the provinces, the local governors, the governors, and those who did the king's business helped the Jews, because the fear of Mordecai had fallen on them. ⁴For Mordecai was great in the king's house, and his fame went out throughout all the provinces, for the man Mordecai grew greater and greater. ⁵The Jews struck all their enemies with the stroke of the sword, and with slaughter and destruction, and did what they wanted to those who hated them. ⁶In the citadel of Susa, the Jews killed and destroyed five hundred men. ⁷They killed Parshandatha, Dalphon, Aspatha, ⁸Poratha, Adalia, Aridatha, ⁹Parmashta, Arisai, Aridai, and Vaizatha, ¹⁰the ten sons of Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Jews' enemy, but they didn't lay their hand on the plunder. ¹¹On that day, the number of those who were slain in the citadel of Susa was brought before the king. ¹²The king said to Esther the queen, "The Jews have slain and destroyed five hundred men in the citadel of Susa, including the ten sons of Haman; what then have they done in the rest of the

king's provinces! Now what is your petition? It shall be granted you. What is your further request? It shall be done." ¹³Then Esther said, "If it pleases the king, let it be granted to the Jews who are in Susa to do tomorrow also according to today's decree, and let Haman's ten sons be hanged on the gallows." ¹⁴The king commanded this to be done. A decree was given out in Susa; and they hanged Haman's ten sons. ¹⁵The Jews who were in Susa gathered themselves together on the fourteenth day also of the month Adar, and killed three hundred men in Susa; but they didn't lay their hand on the plunder. ¹⁶The other Jews who were in the king's provinces gathered themselves together, defended their lives, had rest from their enemies, and killed seventy-five thousand of those who hated them; but they didn't lay their hand on the plunder. ¹⁷This was done on the thirteenth day of the month Adar; and on the fourteenth day of that month they rested and made it a day of feasting and gladness. ¹⁸But the Jews who were in Susa assembled together on the thirteenth and on the fourteenth days of the month; and on the fifteenth day of that month, they rested, and made it a day of feasting and gladness. ¹⁹Therefore the Judeans of the villages, who live in the unwallled towns, make the fourteenth day of the month Adar a day of gladness and feasting, a holiday, and a day of sending presents of food to one another. ²⁰Mordecai wrote these things, and sent letters to all the Jews who were in all the provinces of the King Ahasuerus, both near and far, ²¹to enjoin them that they should keep the fourteenth and fifteenth days of the month Adar yearly, ²²as the days in which the Jews had rest from their enemies, and the month which was turned to them from sorrow to gladness, and from mourning into a holiday; that they should make them days of feasting and gladness, and of sending presents of food to one another, and gifts to the needy. ²³The Jews accepted the custom that they had begun, as Mordecai had written to them, ²⁴because Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Agagite, the enemy of all the Jews, had plotted against the Jews to destroy them, and had cast "Pur", that is the lot, to consume them and to destroy them; ²⁵but when this became known to the king, he commanded by letters that his wicked plan, which he had planned against the Jews, should return on his own head, and that he and his sons should be hanged on the gallows. ²⁶Therefore they called these days "Purim", ^vfrom the word "Pur." Therefore because of all the words of this letter, and of that which they had seen concerning this matter, and that which had come to them, ²⁷the Jews established and imposed on themselves, on their descendants, and on all those who joined themselves to them, so that it should not fail that they would keep these two days according to what was written and according to its appointed time every year; ²⁸and that these days should be remembered and kept throughout every generation, ev-

^vPurim is the Hebrew plural for pur, which means lot.

ery family, every province, and every city; and that these days of Purim should not fail from among the Jews, nor their memory perish from their offspring. ^{vi} 29Then Esther the queen, the daughter of Abihail, and Mordecai the Jew wrote with all authority to confirm this second letter of Purim. ³⁰He sent letters to all the Jews in the hundred twenty-seven provinces of the kingdom of Ahasuerus with words of peace and truth, ³¹to confirm these days of Purim in their appointed times, as Mordecai the Jew and Esther the queen had decreed, and as they had imposed upon themselves and their descendants in the matter of the fastings and their mourning. ³²The commandment of Esther confirmed these matters of Purim; and it was written in the book.

10King Ahasuerus laid a tribute on the land and on the islands of the sea. ²Aren't all the acts of his power and of his might, and the full account of the greatness of Mordecai, to which the king advanced him, written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Media and Persia? ³For Mordecai the Jew was next to King Ahasuerus, and great among the Jews and accepted by the multitude of his brothers, seeking the good of his people and speaking peace to all his descendants.

^{vi}or, seed

Job

¹There was a man in the land of Uz, whose name was Job. That man was blameless and upright, and one who feared God,ⁱ and turned away from evil. ²There were born to him seven sons and three daughters. ³His possessions also were seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred yoke of oxen, five hundred female donkeys, and a very great household; so that this man was the greatest of all the children of the east. ⁴His sons went and held a feast in the house of each one on his birthday; and they sent and called for their three sisters to eat and to drink with them. ⁵It was so, when the days of their feasting had run their course, that Job sent and sanctified them, and rose up early in the morning, and offered burnt offerings according to the number of them all. For Job said, "It may be that my sons have sinned, and renounced God in their hearts." Job did so continually. ⁶Now on the day when God's sons came to present themselves before the LORD,ⁱⁱ Satan also came among them. ⁷The LORD said to Satan, "Where have you come from?" Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, "From going back and forth in the earth, and from walking up and down in it." ⁸The LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant, Job? For there is no one like him in the earth, a blameless and an upright man, one who fears God, and turns away from evil." ⁹Then Satan answered the LORD, and said, "Does Job fear God for nothing? ¹⁰Haven't you made a hedge around him, and around his house, and around all that he has, on every side? You have blessed the work of his hands, and his substance is increased in the land. ¹¹But stretch out your hand now, and touch all that he has, and he will renounce you to your face." ¹²The LORD said to Satan, "Behold,ⁱⁱⁱ all that he has is in your power. Only on himself don't stretch out your hand." So Satan went out from the presence of the LORD. ¹³It fell on a day when his sons and his daughters were eating and drinking wine in their oldest brother's house, ¹⁴that a messenger came to Job, and said, "The oxen were plowing, and the donkeys feeding beside them, ¹⁵and the Sabeans attacked,

and took them away. Yes, they have killed the servants with the edge of the sword, and I alone have escaped to tell you." ¹⁶While he was still speaking, another also came and said, "The fire of God has fallen from the sky, and has burned up the sheep and the servants, and consumed them, and I alone have escaped to tell you." ¹⁷While he was still speaking, another also came and said, "The Kasdim made three bands, and swept down on the camels, and have taken them away, yes, and killed the servants with the edge of the sword; and I alone have escaped to tell you." ¹⁸While he was still speaking, there came also another, and said, "Your sons and your daughters were eating and drinking wine in their oldest brother's house, ¹⁹and behold, there came a great wind from the wilderness, and struck the four corners of the house, and it fell on the young men, and they are dead. I alone have escaped to tell you." ²⁰Then Job arose, and tore his robe, and shaved his head, and fell down on the ground, and worshiped. ²¹He said, "Naked I came out of my mother's womb, and naked will I return there. The LORD gave, and the LORD has taken away. Blessed be the LORD's name." ²²In all this, Job didn't sin, nor charge God with wrongdoing.

²Again, on the day when God's sons came to present themselves before the LORD, Satan came also among them to present himself before the LORD. ²The LORD said to Satan, "Where have you come from?" Satan answered the LORD, and said, "From going back and forth in the earth, and from walking up and down in it." ³The LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant Job? For there is no one like him in the earth, a blameless and an upright man, one who fears God, and turns away from evil. He still maintains his integrity, although you incited me against him, to ruin him without cause." ⁴Satan answered the LORD, and said, "Skin for skin. Yes, all that a man has he will give for his life. ⁵But stretch out your hand now, and touch his bone and his flesh, and he will renounce you to your face." ⁶The LORD said to Satan, "Behold, he is in your hand. Only spare his life." ⁷So Satan went out from the presence of the LORD, and struck Job with painful sores from the sole of his foot to his head. ⁸He took for himself a potsherd to scrape himself with, and he sat among the ashes. ⁹Then his wife said to him, "Do you still

ⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim).

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

maintain your integrity? Renounce God, and die.”¹⁰ But he said to her, “You speak as one of the foolish women would speak. What? Shall we receive good at the hand of God, and shall we not receive evil?” In all this Job didn’t sin with his lips.¹¹ Now when Job’s three friends heard of all this evil that had come on him, they each came from his own place: Eliphaz the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite; and they made an appointment together to come to sympathize with him and to comfort him.¹² When they lifted up their eyes from a distance, and didn’t recognize him, they raised their voices, and wept; and they each tore his robe, and sprinkled dust on their heads toward the sky.¹³ So they sat down with him on the ground seven days and seven nights, and no one spoke a word to him, for they saw that his grief was very great.

³After this Job opened his mouth, and cursed the day of his birth.² Job answered:³ “Let the day perish in which I was born, the night which said, ‘There is a boy conceived.’⁴ Let that day be darkness. Don’t let God from above seek for it, neither let the light shine on it.⁵ Let darkness and the shadow of death claim it for their own. Let a cloud dwell on it. Let all that makes the day black terrify it.⁶ As for that night, let thick darkness seize on it. Let it not rejoice among the days of the year. Let it not come into the number of the months.⁷ Behold, let that night be barren. Let no joyful voice come therein.⁸ Let them curse it who curse the day, who are ready to rouse up leviathan.⁹ Let the stars of its twilight be dark. Let it look for light, but have none, neither let it see the eyelids of the morning,¹⁰ because it didn’t shut up the doors of my mother’s womb, nor did it hide trouble from my eyes.¹¹ “Why didn’t I die from the womb? Why didn’t I give up the spirit when my mother bore me? ¹²Why did the knees receive me? Or why the breast, that I should nurse? ¹³For now I should have lain down and been quiet. I should have slept, then I would have been at rest,¹⁴ with kings and counselors of the earth, who built up waste places for themselves;¹⁵ or with princes who had gold, who filled their houses with silver;¹⁶ or as a hidden untimely birth I had not been, as infants who never saw light.¹⁷ There the wicked cease from troubling. There the weary are at rest.¹⁸ There the prisoners are at ease together. They don’t hear the voice of the taskmaster.¹⁹ The small and the great are there. The servant is free from his master.²⁰ “Why is light given to him who is in misery, life to the bitter in soul,²¹ who long for death, but it doesn’t come; and dig for it more than for hidden treasures,²² who rejoice exceedingly, and are glad, when they can find the grave? ²³Why is light given to a man whose way is hidden, whom God has hedged in?²⁴ For my sighing comes before I eat. My groanings are poured out like water.²⁵ For the thing which I fear comes on me, that which I am afraid of comes to me.²⁶ I am not at ease, neither am I quiet, neither do I have rest; but

trouble comes.”

⁴Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered,² “If someone ventures to talk with you, will you be grieved? But who can withhold himself from speaking? ³Behold, you have instructed many, you have strengthened the weak hands.⁴ Your words have supported him who was falling, you have made the feeble knees firm.⁵ But now it has come to you, and you faint. It touches you, and you are troubled.⁶ Isn’t your piety your confidence? Isn’t the integrity of your ways your hope? ⁷“Remember, now, whoever perished, being innocent? Or where were the upright cut off? ⁸According to what I have seen, those who plow iniquity and sow trouble, reap the same.⁹ By the breath of God they perish. By the blast of his anger are they consumed.¹⁰ The roaring of the lion, and the voice of the fierce lion, the teeth of the young lions, are broken.¹¹ The old lion perishes for lack of prey. The cubs of the lioness are scattered abroad.¹² “Now a thing was secretly brought to me. My ear received a whisper of it.¹³ In thoughts from the visions of the night, when deep sleep falls on men,¹⁴ fear came on me, and trembling, which made all my bones shake.¹⁵ Then a spirit passed before my face. The hair of my flesh stood up.¹⁶ It stood still, but I couldn’t discern its appearance. A form was before my eyes. Silence, then I heard a voice, saying,¹⁷ “Shall mortal man be more just than God? Shall a man be more pure than his Maker? ¹⁸Behold, he puts no trust in his servants. He charges his angels with error.¹⁹ How much more those who dwell in houses of clay, whose foundation is in the dust, who are crushed before the moth!²⁰ Between morning and evening they are destroyed. They perish forever without any regarding it.²¹ Isn’t their tent cord plucked up within them? They die, and that without wisdom.’

⁵“Call now; is there any who will answer you? To which of the holy ones will you turn? ²For resentment kills the foolish man, and jealousy kills the simple.³ I have seen the foolish taking root, but suddenly I cursed his habitation.⁴ His children are far from safety. They are crushed in the gate. Neither is there any to deliver them,⁵ whose harvest the hungry eat up, and take it even out of the thorns. The snare gapes for their substance.⁶ For affliction doesn’t come out of the dust, neither does trouble spring out of the ground;⁷ but man is born to trouble, as the sparks fly upward.⁸ “But as for me, I would seek God. I would commit my cause to God,⁹ who does great things that can’t be fathomed, marvelous things without number;¹⁰ who gives rain on the earth, and sends waters on the fields;¹¹ so that he sets up on high those who are low, those who mourn are exalted to safety.¹² He frustrates the plans of the crafty, so that their hands can’t perform their enterprise.¹³ He takes the wise in their own craftiness; the counsel of the cunning is carried headlong.¹⁴ They meet

with darkness in the day time, and grope at noonday as in the night. ¹⁵But he saves from the sword of their mouth, even the needy from the hand of the mighty. ¹⁶So the poor has hope, and injustice shuts her mouth. ¹⁷“Behold, happy is the man whom God corrects. Therefore do not despise the chastening of the Almighty. ¹⁸For he wounds and binds up. He injures and his hands make whole. ¹⁹He will deliver you in six troubles; yes, in seven no evil will touch you. ²⁰In famine he will redeem you from death; in war, from the power of the sword. ²¹You will be hidden from the scourge of the tongue, neither will you be afraid of destruction when it comes. ²²You will laugh at destruction and famine, neither will you be afraid of the animals of the earth. ²³For you will be allied with the stones of the field. The animals of the field will be at peace with you. ²⁴You will know that your tent is in peace. You will visit your fold, and will miss nothing. ²⁵You will know also that your offspring ^{iv} will be great, your offspring as the grass of the earth. ²⁶You will come to your grave in a full age, like a shock of grain comes in its season. ²⁷Behold, we have researched it. It is so. Hear it, and know it for your good.”

6Then Job answered, ²“Oh that my anguish were weighed, and all my calamity laid in the balances! ³For now it would be heavier than the sand of the seas, therefore my words have been rash. ⁴For the arrows of the Almighty are within me. My spirit drinks up their poison. The terrors of God set themselves in array against me. ⁵Does the wild donkey bray when he has grass? Or does the ox low over his fodder? ⁶Can that which has no flavor be eaten without salt? Or is there any taste in the white of an egg? ⁷My soul refuses to touch them. They are as loathsome food to me. ⁸“Oh that I might have my request, that God would grant the thing that I long for, ⁹even that it would please God to crush me; that he would let loose his hand, and cut me off! ¹⁰Let it still be my consolation, yes, let me exult in pain that doesn’t spare, that I have not denied the words of the Holy One. ¹¹What is my strength, that I should wait? What is my end, that I should be patient? ¹²Is my strength the strength of stones? Or is my flesh of bronze? ¹³Isn’t it that I have no help in me, that wisdom is driven away from me? ¹⁴“To him who is ready to faint, kindness should be shown from his friend; even to him who forsakes the fear of the Almighty. ¹⁵My brothers have dealt deceitfully as a brook, as the channel of brooks that pass away; ¹⁶which are black by reason of the ice, in which the snow hides itself. ¹⁷In the dry season, they vanish. When it is hot, they are consumed out of their place. ¹⁸The caravans that travel beside them turn away. They go up into the waste, and perish. ¹⁹The caravans of Tema looked. The companies of Sheba waited for them. ²⁰They were distressed because they were confident. They came there, and were confounded. ²¹For now you are nothing. You see

a terror, and are afraid. ²²Did I ever say, ‘Give to me?’ or, ‘Offer a present for me from your substance?’ ²³or, ‘Deliver me from the adversary’s hand?’ or, ‘Redeem me from the hand of the oppressors?’ ²⁴“Teach me, and I will hold my peace. Cause me to understand my error. ²⁵How forcible are words of uprightness! But your reproof, what does it reprove? ²⁶Do you intend to reprove words, since the speeches of one who is desperate are as wind? ²⁷Yes, you would even cast lots for the fatherless, and make merchandise of your friend. ²⁸Now therefore be pleased to look at me, for surely I will not lie to your face. ²⁹Please return. Let there be no injustice. Yes, return again. My cause is righteous. ³⁰Is there injustice on my tongue? Can’t my taste discern mischievous things?

7“Isn’t a man forced to labor on earth? Aren’t his days like the days of a hired hand? ²As a servant who earnestly desires the shadow, as a hireling who looks for his wages, ³so I am made to possess months of misery, wearisome nights are appointed to me. ⁴When I lie down, I say, ‘When will I arise, and the night be gone?’ I toss and turn until the dawning of the day. ⁵My flesh is clothed with worms and clods of dust. My skin closes up, and breaks out afresh. ⁶My days are swifter than a weaver’s shuttle, and are spent without hope. ⁷Oh remember that my life is a breath. My eye will no more see good. ⁸The eye of him who sees me will see me no more. Your eyes will be on me, but I will not be. ⁹As the cloud is consumed and vanishes away, so he who goes down to Sheol ^v will come up no more. ¹⁰He will return no more to his house, neither will his place know him any more. ¹¹“Therefore I will not keep silent. I will speak in the anguish of my spirit. I will complain in the bitterness of my soul. ¹²Am I a sea, or a sea monster, that you put a guard over me? ¹³When I say, ‘My bed will comfort me. My couch will ease my complaint,’ ¹⁴then you scare me with dreams and terrify me through visions, ¹⁵so that my soul chooses strangling, death rather than my bones. ¹⁶I loathe my life. I don’t want to live forever. Leave me alone, for my days are but a breath. ¹⁷What is man, that you should magnify him, that you should set your mind on him, ¹⁸that you should visit him every morning, and test him every moment? ¹⁹How long will you not look away from me, nor leave me alone until I swallow down my spittle? ²⁰If I have sinned, what do I do to you, you watcher of men? Why have you set me as a mark for you, so that I am a burden to myself? ²¹Why do you not pardon my disobedience, and take away my iniquity? For now will I lie down in the dust. You will seek me diligently, but I will not be.”

8Then Bildad the Shuhite answered, ²“How long will you speak these things? Shall the words of your mouth be a mighty wind? ³Does God pervert justice? Or does

^{iv}or, seed

^vSheol is the place of the dead.

the Almighty pervert righteousness? ⁴If your children have sinned against him, he has delivered them into the hand of their disobedience. ⁵If you want to seek God diligently, make your supplication to the Almighty. ⁶If you were pure and upright, surely now he would awaken for you, and make the habitation of your righteousness prosperous. ⁷Though your beginning was small, yet your latter end would greatly increase. ⁸"Please inquire of past generations. Find out about the learning of their fathers. ⁹(For we are but of yesterday, and know nothing, because our days on earth are a shadow.) ¹⁰Shall they not teach you, tell you, and utter words out of their heart? ¹¹"Can the papyrus grow up without mire? Can the rushes grow without water? ¹²While it is yet in its greenness, not cut down, it withers before any other reed. ¹³So are the paths of all who forget God. The hope of the godless man will perish, ¹⁴whose confidence will break apart, whose trust is a spider's web. ¹⁵He will lean on his house, but it will not stand. He will cling to it, but it will not endure. ¹⁶He is green before the sun. His shoots go out along his garden. ¹⁷His roots are wrapped around the rock pile. He sees the place of stones. ¹⁸If he is destroyed from his place, then it will deny him, saying, 'I have not seen you.' ¹⁹Behold, this is the joy of his way. Out of the earth, others will spring. ²⁰"Behold, God will not cast away a blameless man, neither will he uphold the evildoers. ²¹He will still fill your mouth with laughter, your lips with shouting. ²²Those who hate you will be clothed with shame. The tent of the wicked will be no more."

⁹Then Job answered, ²"Truly I know that it is so, but how can man be just with God? ³If he is pleased to contend with him, he can't answer him one time in a thousand. ⁴God is wise in heart, and mighty in strength. Who has hardened himself against him and prospered? ⁵He removes the mountains, and they don't know it, when he overturns them in his anger. ⁶He shakes the earth out of its place. Its pillars tremble. ⁷He commands the sun and it doesn't rise, and seals up the stars. ⁸He alone stretches out the heavens, and treads on the waves of the sea. ⁹He makes the Bear, Orion, and the Pleiades, and the rooms of the south. ¹⁰He does great things past finding out; yes, marvelous things without number. ¹¹Behold, he goes by me, and I don't see him. He passes on also, but I don't perceive him. ¹²Behold, he snatches away. Who can hinder him? Who will ask him, 'What are you doing?' ¹³"God will not withdraw his anger. The helpers of Rahab stoop under him. ¹⁴How much less will I answer him, and choose my words to argue with him? ¹⁵Though I were righteous, yet I wouldn't answer him. I would make supplication to my judge. ¹⁶If I had called, and he had answered me, yet I wouldn't believe that he listened to my voice. ¹⁷For he breaks me with a storm, and multiplies my wounds without cause. ¹⁸He will not allow me to catch my breath, but fills me with bitterness.

¹⁹If it is a matter of strength, behold, he is mighty! If of justice, 'Who,' says he, 'will summon me?' ²⁰Though I am righteous, my own mouth will condemn me. Though I am blameless, it will prove me perverse. ²¹I am blameless. I don't respect myself. I despise my life. ²²"It is all the same. Therefore I say he destroys the blameless and the wicked. ²³If the scourge kills suddenly, he will mock at the trial of the innocent. ²⁴The earth is given into the hand of the wicked. He covers the faces of its judges. If not he, then who is it? ²⁵"Now my days are swifter than a runner. They flee away. They see no good. ²⁶They have passed away as the swift ships, as the eagle that swoops on the prey. ²⁷If I say, 'I will forget my complaint, I will put off my sad face, and cheer up,' ²⁸I am afraid of all my sorrows. I know that you will not hold me innocent. ²⁹I will be condemned. Why then do I labor in vain? ³⁰If I wash myself with snow, and cleanse my hands with lye, ³¹yet you will plunge me in the ditch. My own clothes will abhor me. ³²For he is not a man, as I am, that I should answer him, that we should come together in judgment. ³³There is no umpire between us, that might lay his hand on us both. ³⁴Let him take his rod away from me. Let his terror not make me afraid; ³⁵then I would speak, and not fear him, for I am not so in myself.

¹⁰"My soul is weary of my life. I will give free course to my complaint. I will speak in the bitterness of my soul. ²I will tell God, 'Do not condemn me. Show me why you contend with me. ³Is it good to you that you should oppress, that you should despise the work of your hands, and smile on the counsel of the wicked? ⁴Do you have eyes of flesh? Or do you see as man sees? ⁵Are your days as the days of mortals, or your years as man's years, ⁶that you inquire after my iniquity, and search after my sin? ⁷Although you know that I am not wicked, there is no one who can deliver out of your hand. ⁸"Your hands have framed me and fashioned me altogether, yet you destroy me. ⁹Remember, I beg you, that you have fashioned me as clay. Will you bring me into dust again? ¹⁰Haven't you poured me out like milk, and curdled me like cheese? ¹¹You have clothed me with skin and flesh, and knit me together with bones and sinews. ¹²You have granted me life and loving kindness. Your visitation has preserved my spirit. ¹³Yet you hid these things in your heart. I know that this is with you: ¹⁴if I sin, then you mark me. You will not acquit me from my iniquity. ¹⁵If I am wicked, woe to me. If I am righteous, I still will not lift up my head, being filled with disgrace, and conscious of my affliction. ¹⁶If my head is held high, you hunt me like a lion. Again you show yourself powerful to me. ¹⁷You renew your witnesses against me, and increase your indignation on me. Changes and warfare are with me. ¹⁸"Why, then, have you brought me out of the womb? I wish I had given up the spirit, and no eye had seen me. ¹⁹I should have been as though I had

not been. I should have been carried from the womb to the grave. ²⁰Aren't my days few? Stop! Leave me alone, that I may find a little comfort, ²¹before I go where I will not return from, to the land of darkness and of the shadow of death; ²²the land dark as midnight, of the shadow of death, without any order, where the light is as midnight."

11 Then Zophar, the Naamathite, answered, ²"Shouldn't the multitude of words be answered? Should a man full of talk be justified? ³Should your boastings make men hold their peace? When you mock, will no man make you ashamed? ⁴For you say, 'My doctrine is pure. I am clean in your eyes.' ⁵But oh that God would speak, and open his lips against you, ⁶that he would show you the secrets of wisdom! For true wisdom has two sides. Know therefore that God exacts of you less than your iniquity deserves. ⁷"Can you fathom the mystery of God? Or can you probe the limits of the Almighty? ⁸They are high as heaven. What can you do? They are deeper than Sheol. ^{vi} What can you know? ⁹Its measure is longer than the earth, and broader than the sea. ¹⁰If he passes by, or confines, or convenes a court, then who can oppose him? ¹¹For he knows false men. He sees iniquity also, even though he doesn't consider it. ¹²An empty-headed man becomes wise when a man is born as a wild donkey's colt. ¹³"If you set your heart aright, stretch out your hands toward him. ¹⁴If iniquity is in your hand, put it far away. Don't let unrighteousness dwell in your tents. ¹⁵Surely then you will lift up your face without spot. Yes, you will be steadfast, and will not fear, ¹⁶for you will forget your misery. You will remember it like waters that have passed away. ¹⁷Life will be clearer than the noonday. Though there is darkness, it will be as the morning. ¹⁸You will be secure, because there is hope. Yes, you will search, and will take your rest in safety. ¹⁹Also you will lie down, and no one will make you afraid. Yes, many will court your favor. ²⁰But the eyes of the wicked will fail. They will have no way to flee. Their hope will be the giving up of the spirit."

12 Then Job answered, ²"No doubt, but you are the people, and wisdom will die with you. ³But I have understanding as well as you; I am not inferior to you. Yes, who doesn't know such things as these? ⁴I am like one who is a joke to his neighbor, I, who called on God, and he answered. The just, the blameless man is a joke. ⁵In the thought of him who is at ease there is contempt for misfortune. It is ready for them whose foot slips. ⁶The tents of robbers prosper. Those who provoke God are secure, who carry their god in their hands. ⁷"But ask the animals now, and they will teach you; the birds of the sky, and they will tell you. ⁸Or speak to the earth, and it will teach you. The fish of the sea will declare to you. ⁹Who doesn't know that in all these, The LORD's hand has done

this, ¹⁰in whose hand is the life of every living thing, and the breath of all mankind? ¹¹Doesn't the ear try words, even as the palate tastes its food? ¹²With aged men is wisdom, in length of days understanding. ¹³"With God is wisdom and might. He has counsel and understanding. ¹⁴Behold, he breaks down, and it can't be built again. He imprisons a man, and there can be no release. ¹⁵Behold, he withholds the waters, and they dry up. Again, he sends them out, and they overturn the earth. ¹⁶With him is strength and wisdom. The deceived and the deceiver are his. ¹⁷He leads counselors away stripped. He makes judges fools. ¹⁸He loosens the bond of kings. He binds their waist with a belt. ¹⁹He leads priests away stripped, and overthrows the mighty. ²⁰He removes the speech of those who are trusted, and takes away the understanding of the elders. ²¹He pours contempt on princes, and loosens the belt of the strong. ²²He uncovers deep things out of darkness, and brings out to light the shadow of death. ²³He increases the nations, and he destroys them. He enlarges the nations, and he leads them captive. ²⁴He takes away understanding from the chiefs of the people of the earth, and causes them to wander in a wilderness where there is no way. ²⁵They grope in the dark without light. He makes them stagger like a drunken man.

13 "Behold, my eye has seen all this. My ear has heard and understood it. ²What you know, I know also. I am not inferior to you. ³"Surely I would speak to the Almighty. I desire to reason with God. ⁴But you are forgers of lies. You are all physicians of no value. ⁵Oh that you would be completely silent! Then you would be wise. ⁶Hear now my reasoning. Listen to the pleadings of my lips. ⁷Will you speak unrighteously for God, and talk deceitfully for him? ⁸Will you show partiality to him? Will you contend for God? ⁹Is it good that he should search you out? Or as one deceives a man, will you deceive him? ¹⁰He will surely reprove you if you secretly show partiality. ¹¹Won't his majesty make you afraid and his dread fall on you? ¹²Your memorable sayings are proverbs of ashes. Your defenses are defenses of clay. ¹³"Be silent! Leave me alone, that I may speak. Let come on me what will. ¹⁴Why should I take my flesh in my teeth, and put my life in my hand? ¹⁵Behold, he will kill me. I have no hope. Nevertheless, I will maintain my ways before him. ¹⁶This also will be my salvation, that a godless man will not come before him. ¹⁷Listen carefully to my speech. Let my declaration be in your ears. ¹⁸See now, I have set my cause in order. I know that I am righteous. ¹⁹Who is he who will contend with me? For then would I hold my peace and give up the spirit. ²⁰"Only don't do two things to me, then I will not hide myself from your face: ²¹withdraw your hand far from me, and don't let your terror make me afraid. ²²Then call, and I will answer, or let me speak, and you answer me. ²³How many are my iniquities and sins? Make me

^{vi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

know my disobedience and my sin. ²⁴Why do you hide your face, and consider me your enemy? ²⁵Will you harass a driven leaf? Will you pursue the dry stubble? ²⁶For you write bitter things against me, and make me inherit the iniquities of my youth. ²⁷You also put my feet in the stocks, and mark all my paths. You set a bound to the soles of my feet, ²⁸though I am decaying like a rotten thing, like a garment that is moth-eaten.

¹⁴“Man, who is born of a woman, is of few days, and full of trouble. ²He grows up like a flower, and is cut down. He also flees like a shadow, and doesn’t continue. ³Do you open your eyes on such a one, and bring me into judgment with you? ⁴Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? Not one. ⁵Seeing his days are determined, the number of his months is with you, and you have appointed his bounds that he can’t pass. ⁶Look away from him, that he may rest, until he accomplishes, as a hireling, his day. ⁷“For there is hope for a tree if it is cut down, that it will sprout again, that the tender branch of it will not cease. ⁸Though its root grows old in the earth, and its stock dies in the ground, ⁹yet through the scent of water it will bud, and sprout boughs like a plant. ¹⁰But man dies, and is laid low. Yes, man gives up the spirit, and where is he? ¹¹As the waters fail from the sea, and the river wastes and dries up, ¹²so man lies down and doesn’t rise. Until the heavens are no more, they will not awake, nor be roused out of their sleep. ¹³“Oh that you would hide me in Sheol, ^{vii} that you would keep me secret until your wrath is past, that you would appoint me a set time and remember me! ¹⁴If a man dies, will he live again? I would wait all the days of my warfare, until my release should come. ¹⁵You would call, and I would answer you. You would have a desire for the work of your hands. ¹⁶But now you count my steps. Don’t you watch over my sin? ¹⁷My disobedience is sealed up in a bag. You fasten up my iniquity. ¹⁸“But the mountain falling comes to nothing. The rock is removed out of its place. ¹⁹The waters wear the stones. The torrents of it wash away the dust of the earth. So you destroy the hope of man. ²⁰You forever prevail against him, and he departs. You change his face, and send him away. ²¹His sons come to honor, and he doesn’t know it. They are brought low, but he doesn’t perceive it of them. ²²But his flesh on him has pain, and his soul within him mourns.”

¹⁵Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered, ²“Should a wise man answer with vain knowledge, and fill himself with the east wind? ³Should he reason with unprofitable talk, or with speeches with which he can do no good? ⁴Yes, you do away with fear, and hinder devotion before God. ⁵For your iniquity teaches your mouth, and you choose the language of the crafty. ⁶Your own mouth condemns you, and not I. Yes, your own lips testify against you. ⁷“Are you

the first man who was born? Or were you brought out before the hills? ⁸Have you heard the secret counsel of God? Do you limit wisdom to yourself? ⁹What do you know that we don’t know? What do you understand which is not in us? ¹⁰With us are both the gray-headed and the very aged men, much older than your father. ¹¹Are the consolations of God too small for you, even the word that is gentle toward you? ¹²Why does your heart carry you away? Why do your eyes flash, ¹³that you turn your spirit against God, and let such words go out of your mouth? ¹⁴What is man, that he should be clean? What is he who is born of a woman, that he should be righteous? ¹⁵Behold, he puts no trust in his holy ones. Yes, the heavens are not clean in his sight; ¹⁶how much less one who is abominable and corrupt, a man who drinks iniquity like water! ¹⁷“I will show you, listen to me; that which I have seen I will declare ¹⁸(which wise men have told by their fathers, and have not hidden it; ¹⁹to whom alone the land was given, and no stranger passed among them): ²⁰the wicked man writhes in pain all his days, even the number of years that are laid up for the oppressor. ²¹A sound of terrors is in his ears. In prosperity the destroyer will come on him. ²²He doesn’t believe that he will return out of darkness. He is waited for by the sword. ²³He wanders abroad for bread, saying, ‘Where is it?’ He knows that the day of darkness is ready at his hand. ²⁴Distress and anguish make him afraid. They prevail against him, as a king ready to the battle. ²⁵Because he has stretched out his hand against God, and behaves himself proudly against the Almighty, ²⁶he runs at him with a stiff neck, with the thick shields of his bucklers, ²⁷because he has covered his face with his fatness, and gathered fat on his thighs. ²⁸He has lived in desolate cities, in houses which no one inhabited, which were ready to become heaps. ²⁹He will not be rich, neither will his substance continue, neither will their possessions be extended on the earth. ³⁰He will not depart out of darkness. The flame will dry up his branches. He will go away by the breath of God’s mouth. ³¹Let him not trust in emptiness, deceiving himself, for emptiness will be his reward. ³²It will be accomplished before his time. His branch will not be green. ³³He will shake off his unripe grape as the vine, and will cast off his flower as the olive tree. ³⁴For the company of the godless will be barren, and fire will consume the tents of bribery. ³⁵They conceive mischief and produce iniquity. Their heart prepares deceit.”

¹⁶Then Job answered, ²“I have heard many such things. You are all miserable comforters! ³Shall vain words have an end? Or what provokes you that you answer? ⁴I also could speak as you do. If your soul were in my soul’s place, I could join words together against you, and shake my head at you, ⁵but I would strengthen you with my mouth. The solace of my lips would relieve you. ⁶“Though I speak, my grief is not subsided. Though I forbear, what am I eased?

^{vii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

⁷But now, God, you have surely worn me out. You have made all my company desolate. ⁸You have shriveled me up. This is a witness against me. My leanness rises up against me. It testifies to my face. ⁹He has torn me in his wrath and persecuted me. He has gnashed on me with his teeth. My adversary sharpens his eyes on me. ¹⁰They have gaped on me with their mouth. They have struck me on the cheek reproachfully. They gather themselves together against me. ¹¹God delivers me to the ungodly, and casts me into the hands of the wicked. ¹²I was at ease, and he broke me apart. Yes, he has taken me by the neck, and dashed me to pieces. He has also set me up for his target. ¹³His archers surround me. He splits my kidneys apart, and does not spare. He pours out my bile on the ground. ¹⁴He breaks me with breach on breach. He runs at me like a giant. ¹⁵I have sewed sackcloth on my skin, and have thrust my horn in the dust. ¹⁶My face is red with weeping. Deep darkness is on my eyelids, ¹⁷although there is no violence in my hands, and my prayer is pure. ¹⁸“Earth, don’t cover my blood. Let my cry have no place to rest. ¹⁹Even now, behold, my witness is in heaven. He who vouches for me is on high. ²⁰My friends scoff at me. My eyes pour out tears to God, ²¹that he would maintain the right of a man with God, of a son of man with his neighbor! ²²For when a few years have come, I will go the way of no return.

¹⁷“My spirit is consumed. My days are extinct and the grave is ready for me. ²Surely there are mockers with me. My eye dwells on their provocation. ³“Now give a pledge. Be collateral for me with yourself. Who is there who will strike hands with me? ⁴For you have hidden their heart from understanding, therefore you will not exalt them. ⁵He who denounces his friends for plunder, even the eyes of his children will fail. ⁶“But he has made me a byword of the people. They spit in my face. ⁷My eye also is dim by reason of sorrow. All my members are as a shadow. ⁸Upright men will be astonished at this. The innocent will stir himself up against the godless. ⁹Yet the righteous will hold to his way. He who has clean hands will grow stronger and stronger. ¹⁰But as for you all, come back. I will not find a wise man among you. ¹¹My days are past. My plans are broken off, as are the thoughts of my heart. ¹²They change the night into day, saying ‘The light is near’ in the presence of darkness. ¹³If I look for Sheol ^{viii} as my house, if I have spread my couch in the darkness, ¹⁴if I have said to corruption, ‘You are my father,’ and to the worm, ‘My mother,’ and ‘My sister,’ ¹⁵where then is my hope? As for my hope, who will see it? ¹⁶Shall it go down with me to the gates of Sheol, ^{ix} or descend together into the dust?”

^{viii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{ix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

¹⁸Then Bildad the Shuhite answered, ²“How long will you hunt for words? Consider, and afterwards we will speak. ³Why are we counted as animals, which have become unclean in your sight? ⁴You who tear yourself in your anger, will the earth be forsaken for you? Or will the rock be removed out of its place? ⁵“Yes, the light of the wicked will be put out. The spark of his fire won’t shine. ⁶The light will be dark in his tent. His lamp above him will be put out. ⁷The steps of his strength will be shortened. His own counsel will cast him down. ⁸For he is cast into a net by his own feet, and he wanders into its mesh. ⁹A snare will take him by the heel. A trap will catch him. ¹⁰A noose is hidden for him in the ground, a trap for him on the path. ¹¹Terrors will make him afraid on every side, and will chase him at his heels. ¹²His strength will be famished. Calamity will be ready at his side. ¹³The members of his body will be devoured. The firstborn of death will devour his members. ¹⁴He will be rooted out of the security of his tent. He will be brought to the king of terrors. ¹⁵There will dwell in his tent that which is none of his. Sulfur will be scattered on his habitation. ¹⁶His roots will be dried up beneath. His branch will be cut off above. ¹⁷His memory will perish from the earth. He will have no name in the street. ¹⁸He will be driven from light into darkness, and chased out of the world. ¹⁹He will have neither son nor grandson among his people, nor any remaining where he lived. ²⁰Those who come after will be astonished at his day, as those who went before were frightened. ²¹Surely such are the dwellings of the unrighteous. This is the place of him who doesn’t know God.”

¹⁹Then Job answered, ²“How long will you torment me, and crush me with words? ³You have reproached me ten times. You aren’t ashamed that you attack me. ⁴If it is true that I have erred, my error remains with myself. ⁵If indeed you will magnify yourselves against me, and plead against me my reproach, ⁶know now that God has subverted me, and has surrounded me with his net. ⁷“Behold, I cry out of wrong, but I am not heard. I cry for help, but there is no justice. ⁸He has walled up my way so that I can’t pass, and has set darkness in my paths. ⁹He has stripped me of my glory, and taken the crown from my head. ¹⁰He has broken me down on every side, and I am gone. He has plucked my hope up like a tree. ¹¹He has also kindled his wrath against me. He counts me among his adversaries. ¹²His troops come on together, build a siege ramp against me, and encamp around my tent. ¹³“He has put my brothers far from me. My acquaintances are wholly estranged from me. ¹⁴My relatives have gone away. My familiar friends have forgotten me. ¹⁵Those who dwell in my house and my maids consider me a stranger. I am an alien in their sight. ¹⁶I call to my servant, and he gives me no answer. I beg him with my mouth. ¹⁷My breath is offensive to my wife. I am loathsome to the children of my

own mother. ¹⁸Even young children despise me. If I arise, they speak against me. ¹⁹All my familiar friends abhor me. They whom I loved have turned against me. ²⁰My bones stick to my skin and to my flesh. I have escaped by the skin of my teeth. ²¹“Have pity on me. Have pity on me, you my friends, for the hand of God has touched me. ²²Why do you persecute me as God, and are not satisfied with my flesh? ²³“Oh that my words were now written! Oh that they were inscribed in a book! ²⁴That with an iron pen and lead they were engraved in the rock forever! ²⁵But as for me, I know that my Redeemer lives. In the end, he will stand upon the earth. ²⁶After my skin is destroyed, then I will see God in my flesh, ²⁷whom I, even I, will see on my side. My eyes will see, and not as a stranger. “My heart is consumed within me. ²⁸If you say, ‘How we will persecute him!’ because the root of the matter is found in me, ²⁹be afraid of the sword, for wrath brings the punishments of the sword, that you may know there is a judgment.”

20Then Zophar the Naamathite answered, ²“Therefore my thoughts answer me, even by reason of my haste that is in me. ³I have heard the reproof which puts me to shame. The spirit of my understanding answers me. ⁴Don’t you know this from old time, since man was placed on earth, ⁵that the triumphing of the wicked is short, the joy of the godless but for a moment? ⁶Though his height mount up to the heavens, and his head reach to the clouds, ⁷yet he will perish forever like his own dung. Those who have seen him will say, ‘Where is he?’ ⁸He will fly away as a dream, and will not be found. Yes, he will be chased away like a vision of the night. ⁹The eye which saw him will see him no more, neither will his place see him any more. ¹⁰His children will seek the favor of the poor. His hands will give back his wealth. ¹¹His bones are full of his youth, but youth will lie down with him in the dust. ¹²“Though wickedness is sweet in his mouth, though he hide it under his tongue, ¹³though he spare it, and will not let it go, but keep it still within his mouth, ¹⁴yet his food in his bowels is turned. It is cobra venom within him. ¹⁵He has swallowed down riches, and he will vomit them up again. God will cast them out of his belly. ¹⁶He will suck cobra venom. The viper’s tongue will kill him. ¹⁷He will not look at the rivers, the flowing streams of honey and butter. ¹⁸He will restore that for which he labored, and will not swallow it down. He will not rejoice according to the substance that he has gotten. ¹⁹For he has oppressed and forsaken the poor. He has violently taken away a house, and he will not build it up. ²⁰“Because he knew no quietness within him, he will not save anything of that in which he delights. ²¹There was nothing left that he didn’t devour, therefore his prosperity will not endure. ²²In the fullness of his sufficiency, distress will overtake him. The hand of everyone who is in misery will come on him. ²³When he is about to fill his belly, God will cast the fierceness of

his wrath on him. It will rain on him while he is eating. ²⁴He will flee from the iron weapon. The bronze arrow will strike him through. ²⁵He draws it out, and it comes out of his body. Yes, the glittering point comes out of his liver. Terrors are on him. ²⁶All darkness is laid up for his treasures. An unfanned fire will devour him. It will consume that which is left in his tent. ²⁷The heavens will reveal his iniquity. The earth will rise up against him. ²⁸The increase of his house will depart. They will rush away in the day of his wrath. ²⁹This is the portion of a wicked man from God, the heritage appointed to him by God.”

21Then Job answered, ²“Listen diligently to my speech. Let this be your consolation. ³Allow me, and I also will speak. After I have spoken, mock on. ⁴As for me, is my complaint to man? Why shouldn’t I be impatient? ⁵Look at me, and be astonished. Lay your hand on your mouth. ⁶When I remember, I am troubled. Horror takes hold of my flesh. ⁷“Why do the wicked live, become old, yes, and grow mighty in power? ⁸Their child is established with them in their sight, their offspring before their eyes. ⁹Their houses are safe from fear, neither is the rod of God upon them. ¹⁰Their bulls breed without fail. Their cows calve, and don’t miscarry. ¹¹They send out their little ones like a flock. Their children dance. ¹²They sing to the tambourine and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the pipe. ¹³They spend their days in prosperity. In an instant they go down to Sheol. ¹⁴They tell God, ‘Depart from us, for we don’t want to know about your ways. ¹⁵What is the Almighty, that we should serve him? What profit should we have, if we pray to him?’ ¹⁶Behold, their prosperity is not in their hand. The counsel of the wicked is far from me. ¹⁷“How often is it that the lamp of the wicked is put out, that their calamity comes on them, that God distributes sorrows in his anger? ¹⁸How often is it that they are as stubble before the wind, as chaff that the storm carries away? ¹⁹You say, ‘God lays up his iniquity for his children.’ Let him recompense it to himself, that he may know it. ²⁰Let his own eyes see his destruction. Let him drink of the wrath of the Almighty. ²¹For what does he care for his house after him, when the number of his months is cut off? ²²“Shall any teach God knowledge, since he judges those who are high? ²³One dies in his full strength, being wholly at ease and quiet. ²⁴His pails are full of milk. The marrow of his bones is moistened. ²⁵Another dies in bitterness of soul, and never tastes of good. ²⁶They lie down alike in the dust. The worm covers them. ²⁷“Behold, I know your thoughts, the plans with which you would wrong me. ²⁸For you say, ‘Where is the house of the prince? Where is the tent in which the wicked lived?’ ²⁹Haven’t you asked wayfaring men? Don’t you know their evidences, ³⁰that the evil man is reserved to the day of calamity, that they are led out to

^xSheol is the place of the dead.

the day of wrath? ³¹Who will declare his way to his face? Who will repay him what he has done? ³²Yet he will be borne to the grave. Men will keep watch over the tomb. ³³The clods of the valley will be sweet to him. All men will draw after him, as there were innumerable before him. ³⁴So how can you comfort me with nonsense, because in your answers there remains only falsehood?"

22 Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered, ²"Can a man be profitable to God? Surely he who is wise is profitable to himself. ³Is it any pleasure to the Almighty that you are righteous? Or does it benefit him that you make your ways perfect? ⁴Is it for your piety that he reproves you, that he enters with you into judgment? ⁵Isn't your wickedness great? Neither is there any end to your iniquities. ⁶For you have taken pledges from your brother for nothing, and stripped the naked of their clothing. ⁷You haven't given water to the weary to drink, and you have withheld bread from the hungry. ⁸But as for the mighty man, he had the earth. The honorable man, he lived in it. ⁹You have sent widows away empty, and the arms of the fatherless have been broken. ¹⁰Therefore snares are around you. Sudden fear troubles you, ¹¹or darkness, so that you can not see, and floods of waters cover you. ¹²"Isn't God in the heights of heaven? See the height of the stars, how high they are! ¹³You say, 'What does God know? Can he judge through the thick darkness?' ¹⁴Thick clouds are a covering to him, so that he doesn't see. He walks on the vault of the sky.' ¹⁵Will you keep the old way, which wicked men have trodden, ¹⁶who were snatched away before their time, whose foundation was poured out as a stream, ¹⁷who said to God, 'Depart from us!' and, 'What can the Almighty do for us?' ¹⁸Yet he filled their houses with good things, but the counsel of the wicked is far from me. ¹⁹The righteous see it, and are glad. The innocent ridicule them, ²⁰saying, 'Surely those who rose up against us are cut off. The fire has consumed their remnant.' ²¹"Acquaint yourself with him now, and be at peace. By it, good will come to you. ²²Please receive instruction from his mouth, and lay up his words in your heart. ²³If you return to the Almighty, you will be built up, if you put away unrighteousness far from your tents. ²⁴Lay your treasure in the dust, the gold of Ophir among the stones of the brooks. ²⁵The Almighty will be your treasure, and precious silver to you. ²⁶For then you will delight yourself in the Almighty, and will lift up your face to God. ²⁷You will make your prayer to him, and he will hear you. You will pay your vows. ²⁸You will also decree a thing, and it will be established to you. Light will shine on your ways. ²⁹When they cast down, you will say, 'be lifted up.' He will save the humble person. ³⁰He will even deliver him who is not innocent. Yes, he will be delivered through the cleanness of your hands."

23 Then Job answered, ²"Even today my complaint is

rebellious. His hand is heavy in spite of my groaning. ³Oh that I knew where I might find him! That I might come even to his seat! ⁴I would set my cause in order before him, and fill my mouth with arguments. ⁵I would know the words which he would answer me, and understand what he would tell me. ⁶Would he contend with me in the greatness of his power? No, but he would listen to me. ⁷There the upright might reason with him, so I should be delivered forever from my judge. ⁸"If I go east, he is not there. If I go west, I can't find him. ⁹He works to the north, but I can't see him. He turns south, but I can't catch a glimpse of him. ¹⁰But he knows the way that I take. When he has tried me, I will come out like gold. ¹¹My foot has held fast to his steps. I have kept his way, and not turned away. ¹²I haven't gone back from the commandment of his lips. I have treasured up the words of his mouth more than my necessary food. ¹³But he stands alone, and who can oppose him? What his soul desires, even that he does. ¹⁴For he performs that which is appointed for me. Many such things are with him. ¹⁵Therefore I am terrified at his presence. When I consider, I am afraid of him. ¹⁶For God has made my heart faint. The Almighty has terrified me. ¹⁷Because I was not cut off before the darkness, neither did he cover the thick darkness from my face.

24 "Why aren't times laid up by the Almighty? Why don't those who know him see his days? ²There are people who remove the landmarks. They violently take away flocks, and feed them. ³They drive away the donkey of the fatherless, and they take the widow's ox for a pledge. ⁴They turn the needy out of the way. The poor of the earth all hide themselves. ⁵Behold, as wild donkeys in the desert, they go out to their work, seeking diligently for food. The wilderness yields them bread for their children. ⁶They cut their food in the field. They glean the vineyard of the wicked. ⁷They lie all night naked without clothing, and have no covering in the cold. ⁸They are wet with the showers of the mountains, and embrace the rock for lack of a shelter. ⁹There are those who pluck the fatherless from the breast, and take a pledge of the poor, ¹⁰so that they go around naked without clothing. Being hungry, they carry the sheaves. ¹¹They make oil within the walls of these men. They tread wine presses, and suffer thirst. ¹²From out of the populous city, men groan. The soul of the wounded cries out, yet God doesn't regard the folly. ¹³"These are of those who rebel against the light. They don't know its ways, nor stay in its paths. ¹⁴The murderer rises with the light. He kills the poor and needy. In the night he is like a thief. ¹⁵The eye also of the adulterer waits for the twilight, saying, 'No eye will see me.' He disguises his face. ¹⁶In the dark they dig through houses. They shut themselves up in the daytime. They don't know the light. ¹⁷For the morning is to all of them like thick darkness, for they know the terrors of the thick darkness. ¹⁸"They are foam on the

surface of the waters. Their portion is cursed in the earth. They don't turn into the way of the vineyards. ¹⁹Drought and heat consume the snow waters, so does Sheol ^{xi} those who have sinned. ²⁰The womb will forget him. The worm will feed sweetly on him. He will be no more remembered. Unrighteousness will be broken as a tree. ²¹He devours the barren who don't bear. He shows no kindness to the widow. ²²Yet God preserves the mighty by his power. He rises up who has no assurance of life. ²³God gives them security, and they rest in it. His eyes are on their ways. ²⁴They are exalted; yet a little while, and they are gone. Yes, they are brought low, they are taken out of the way as all others, and are cut off as the tops of the ears of grain. ²⁵If it isn't so now, who will prove me a liar, and make my speech worth nothing?"

25Then Bildad the Shuhite answered, ²"Dominion and fear are with him. He makes peace in his high places. ³Can his armies be counted? On whom does his light not arise? ⁴How then can man be just with God? Or how can he who is born of a woman be clean? ⁵Behold, even the moon has no brightness, and the stars are not pure in his sight; ⁶How much less man, who is a worm, and the son of man, who is a worm!"

26Then Job answered, ²"How have you helped him who is without power! How have you saved the arm that has no strength! ³How have you counseled him who has no wisdom, and plentifully declared sound knowledge! ⁴To whom have you uttered words? Whose spirit came out of you? ⁵"The departed spirits tremble, those beneath the waters and all that live in them. ⁶Sheol ^{xii} is naked before God, and Abaddon ^{xiii} has no covering. ⁷He stretches out the north over empty space, and hangs the earth on nothing. ⁸He binds up the waters in his thick clouds, and the cloud is not burst under them. ⁹He encloses the face of his throne, and spreads his cloud on it. ¹⁰He has described a boundary on the surface of the waters, and to the confines of light and darkness. ¹¹The pillars of heaven tremble and are astonished at his rebuke. ¹²He stirs up the sea with his power, and by his understanding he strikes through Rahab. ¹³By his Spirit the heavens are garnished. His hand has pierced the swift serpent. ¹⁴Behold, these are but the outskirts of his ways. How small a whisper do we hear of him! But the thunder of his power who can understand?"

27Job again took up his parable, and said, ²"As God lives, who has taken away my right, the Almighty, who has made my soul bitter ³(for the length of my life is still in me, and the spirit of God is in my nostrils); ⁴surely my lips will not speak unrighteousness, neither will my tongue

utter deceit. ⁵Far be it from me that I should justify you. Until I die I will not put away my integrity from me. ⁶I hold fast to my righteousness, and will not let it go. My heart will not reproach me so long as I live. ⁷"Let my enemy be as the wicked. Let him who rises up against me be as the unrighteous. ⁸For what is the hope of the godless, when he is cut off, when God takes away his life? ⁹Will God hear his cry when trouble comes on him? ¹⁰Will he delight himself in the Almighty, and call on God at all times? ¹¹I will teach you about the hand of God. I will not conceal that which is with the Almighty. ¹²Behold, all of you have seen it yourselves; why then have you become altogether vain? ¹³"This is the portion of a wicked man with God, the heritage of oppressors, which they receive from the Almighty. ¹⁴If his children are multiplied, it is for the sword. His offspring will not be satisfied with bread. ¹⁵Those who remain of him will be buried in death. His widows will make no lamentation. ¹⁶Though he heap up silver as the dust, and prepare clothing as the clay; ¹⁷he may prepare it, but the just will put it on, and the innocent will divide the silver. ¹⁸He builds his house as the moth, as a booth which the watchman makes. ¹⁹He lies down rich, but he will not do so again. He opens his eyes, and he is not. ²⁰Terrors overtake him like waters. A storm steals him away in the night. ²¹The east wind carries him away, and he departs. It sweeps him out of his place. ²²For it hurls at him, and does not spare, as he flees away from his hand. ²³Men will clap their hands at him, and will hiss him out of his place.

28"Surely there is a mine for silver, and a place for gold which they refine. ²Iron is taken out of the earth, and copper is smelted out of the ore. ³Man sets an end to darkness, and searches out, to the furthest bound, the stones of obscurity and of thick darkness. ⁴He breaks open a shaft away from where people live. They are forgotten by the foot. They hang far from men, they swing back and forth. ⁵As for the earth, out of it comes bread. Underneath it is turned up as it were by fire. ⁶Sapphires come from its rocks. It has dust of gold. ⁷That path no bird of prey knows, neither has the falcon's eye seen it. ⁸The proud animals have not trodden it, nor has the fierce lion passed by there. ⁹He puts his hand on the flinty rock, and he overturns the mountains by the roots. ¹⁰He cuts out channels among the rocks. His eye sees every precious thing. ¹¹He binds the streams that they don't trickle. The thing that is hidden he brings out to light. ¹²"But where will wisdom be found? Where is the place of understanding? ¹³Man doesn't know its price, and it isn't found in the land of the living. ¹⁴The deep says, 'It isn't in me.' The sea says, 'It isn't with me.' ¹⁵It can't be gotten for gold, neither will silver be weighed for its price. ¹⁶It can't be valued with the gold of Ophir, with the precious onyx, or the sapphire.

^{xi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xiii}Abaddon means Destroyer.

xiv ¹⁷Gold and glass can't equal it, neither will it be exchanged for jewels of fine gold. ¹⁸No mention will be made of coral or of crystal. Yes, the price of wisdom is above rubies. ¹⁹The topaz of Ethiopia will not equal it. It won't be valued with pure gold. ²⁰Where then does wisdom come from? Where is the place of understanding? ²¹Seeing it is hidden from the eyes of all living, and kept close from the birds of the sky. ²²Destruction and Death say, 'We have heard a rumor of it with our ears.' ²³"God understands its way, and he knows its place. ²⁴For he looks to the ends of the earth, and sees under the whole sky. ²⁵He establishes the force of the wind. Yes, he measures out the waters by measure. ²⁶When he made a decree for the rain, and a way for the lightning of the thunder, ²⁷then he saw it, and declared it. He established it, yes, and searched it out. ²⁸To man he said, 'Behold, the fear of the Lord,'^{xv} that is wisdom. To depart from evil is understanding.'"

29Job again took up his parable, and said, ²"Oh that I were as in the months of old, as in the days when God watched over me; ³when his lamp shone on my head, and by his light I walked through darkness, ⁴as I was in my prime, when the friendship of God was in my tent, ⁵when the Almighty was yet with me, and my children were around me, ⁶when my steps were washed with butter, and the rock poured out streams of oil for me, ⁷when I went out to the city gate, when I prepared my seat in the street. ⁸The young men saw me and hid themselves. The aged rose up and stood. ⁹The princes refrained from talking, and laid their hand on their mouth. ¹⁰The voice of the nobles was hushed, and their tongue stuck to the roof of their mouth. ¹¹For when the ear heard me, then it blessed me, and when the eye saw me, it commended me, ¹²because I delivered the poor who cried, and the fatherless also, who had no one to help him, ¹³the blessing of him who was ready to perish came on me, and I caused the widow's heart to sing for joy. ¹⁴I put on righteousness, and it clothed me. My justice was as a robe and a diadem. ¹⁵I was eyes to the blind, and feet to the lame. ¹⁶I was a father to the needy. I researched the cause of him whom I didn't know. ¹⁷I broke the jaws of the unrighteous and plucked the prey out of his teeth. ¹⁸Then I said, 'I will die in my own house, I will count my days as the sand. ¹⁹My root is spread out to the waters. The dew lies all night on my branch. ²⁰My glory is fresh in me. My bow is renewed in my hand.' ²¹"Men listened to me, waited, and kept silence for my counsel. ²²After my words they didn't speak again. My speech fell on them. ²³They waited for me as for the rain. Their mouths drank as with the spring rain. ²⁴I smiled on them when they had no confidence. They didn't reject the light of my face. ²⁵I chose out their way, and sat as

chief. I lived as a king in the army, as one who comforts the mourners.

30"But now those who are younger than I have me in derision, whose fathers I considered unworthy to put with my sheep dogs. ²Of what use is the strength of their hands to me, men in whom ripe age has perished? ³They are gaunt from lack and famine. They gnaw the dry ground, in the gloom of waste and desolation. ⁴They pluck salt herbs by the bushes. The roots of the broom tree are their food. ⁵They are driven out from among men. They cry after them as after a thief, ⁶so that they live in frightful valleys, and in holes of the earth and of the rocks. ⁷They bray among the bushes. They are gathered together under the nettles. ⁸They are children of fools, yes, children of wicked men. They were flogged out of the land. ⁹"Now I have become their song. Yes, I am a byword to them. ¹⁰They abhor me, they stand aloof from me, and don't hesitate to spit in my face. ¹¹For he has untied his cord, and afflicted me; and they have thrown off restraint before me. ¹²On my right hand rise the rabble. They thrust aside my feet. They cast their ways of destruction up against me. ¹³They mar my path. They promote my destruction without anyone's help. ¹⁴As through a wide breach they come. They roll themselves in amid the ruin. ¹⁵Terrors have turned on me. They chase my honor as the wind. My welfare has passed away as a cloud. ¹⁶"Now my soul is poured out within me. Days of affliction have taken hold of me. ¹⁷In the night season my bones are pierced in me, and the pains that gnaw me take no rest. ¹⁸My garment is disfigured by great force. It binds me about as the collar of my tunic. ¹⁹He has cast me into the mire. I have become like dust and ashes. ²⁰I cry to you, and you do not answer me. I stand up, and you gaze at me. ²¹You have turned to be cruel to me. With the might of your hand you persecute me. ²²You lift me up to the wind, and drive me with it. You dissolve me in the storm. ²³For I know that you will bring me to death, to the house appointed for all living. ²⁴"However doesn't one stretch out a hand in his fall? Or in his calamity therefore cry for help? ²⁵Didn't I weep for him who was in trouble? Wasn't my soul grieved for the needy? ²⁶When I looked for good, then evil came. When I waited for light, darkness came. ²⁷My heart is troubled, and doesn't rest. Days of affliction have come on me. ²⁸I go mourning without the sun. I stand up in the assembly, and cry for help. ²⁹I am a brother to jackals, and a companion to ostriches. ³⁰My skin grows black and peels from me. My bones are burned with heat. ³¹Therefore my harp has turned to mourning, and my pipe into the voice of those who weep.

31"I made a covenant with my eyes; how then should I look lustfully at a young woman? ²For what is the portion from God above, and the heritage from the Almighty on

^{xiv}or, lapis lazuli

^{xv}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

high? ³Is it not calamity to the unrighteous, and disaster to the workers of iniquity? ⁴Doesn't he see my ways, and count all my steps? ⁵"If I have walked with falsehood, and my foot has hurried to deceit ⁶(let me be weighed in an even balance, that God may know my integrity); ⁷if my step has turned out of the way, if my heart walked after my eyes, if any defilement has stuck to my hands, ⁸then let me sow, and let another eat. Yes, let the produce of my field be rooted out. ⁹"If my heart has been enticed to a woman, and I have laid wait at my neighbor's door, ¹⁰then let my wife grind for another, and let others sleep with her. ¹¹For that would be a heinous crime. Yes, it would be an iniquity to be punished by the judges, ¹²for it is a fire that consumes to destruction, and would root out all my increase. ¹³"If I have despised the cause of my male servant or of my female servant, when they contended with me, ¹⁴what then will I do when God rises up? When he visits, what will I answer him? ¹⁵Didn't he who made me in the womb make him? Didn't one fashion us in the womb? ¹⁶"If I have withheld the poor from their desire, or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail, ¹⁷or have eaten my morsel alone, and the fatherless has not eaten of it ¹⁸(no, from my youth he grew up with me as with a father, I have guided her from my mother's womb); ¹⁹if I have seen any perish for want of clothing, or that the needy had no covering; ²⁰if his heart hasn't blessed me, if he hasn't been warmed with my sheep's fleece; ²¹if I have lifted up my hand against the fatherless, because I saw my help in the gate; ²²then let my shoulder fall from the shoulder blade, and my arm be broken from the bone. ²³For calamity from God is a terror to me. Because of his majesty, I can do nothing. ²⁴"If I have made gold my hope, and have said to the fine gold, 'You are my confidence;' ²⁵If I have rejoiced because my wealth was great, and because my hand had gotten much; ²⁶if I have seen the sun when it shined, or the moon moving in splendor, ²⁷and my heart has been secretly enticed, and my hand threw a kiss from my mouth; ²⁸this also would be an iniquity to be punished by the judges, for I should have denied the God who is above. ²⁹"If I have rejoiced at the destruction of him who hated me, or lifted up myself when evil found him ³⁰(I have certainly not allowed my mouth to sin by asking his life with a curse); ³¹if the men of my tent have not said, 'Who can find one who has not been filled with his meat?' ³²(the foreigner has not camped in the street, but I have opened my doors to the traveler); ³³if like Adam I have covered my transgressions, by hiding my iniquity in my heart, ³⁴because I feared the great multitude, and the contempt of families terrified me, so that I kept silence, and didn't go out of the door— ³⁵oh that I had one to hear me! Behold, here is my signature! Let the Almighty answer me! Let the accuser write my indictment! ³⁶Surely I would carry it on my shoulder, and I would bind it to me as a crown. ³⁷I would declare to him the number of my steps. I would go near to him like a

prince. ³⁸If my land cries out against me, and its furrows weep together; ³⁹if I have eaten its fruits without money, or have caused its owners to lose their life, ⁴⁰let briars grow instead of wheat, and stinkweed instead of barley." The words of Job are ended.

32 So these three men ceased to answer Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes. ²Then the wrath of Elihu the son of Barachel, the Buzite, of the family of Ram, was kindled against Job. His wrath was kindled because he justified himself rather than God. ³Also his wrath was kindled against his three friends, because they had found no answer, and yet had condemned Job. ⁴Now Elihu had waited to speak to Job, because they were elder than he. ⁵When Elihu saw that there was no answer in the mouth of these three men, his wrath was kindled. ⁶Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite answered, "I am young, and you are very old. Therefore I held back, and didn't dare show you my opinion. ⁷I said, 'Days should speak, and multitude of years should teach wisdom.' ⁸But there is a spirit in man, and the Spirit ^{xvi} of the Almighty gives them understanding. ⁹It is not the great who are wise, nor the aged who understand justice. ¹⁰Therefore I said, 'Listen to me; I also will show my opinion.' ¹¹"Behold, I waited for your words, and I listened for your reasoning, while you searched out what to say. ¹²Yes, I gave you my full attention, but there was no one who convinced Job, or who answered his words, among you. ¹³Beware lest you say, 'We have found wisdom. God may refute him, not man;' ¹⁴for he has not directed his words against me; neither will I answer him with your speeches. ¹⁵"They are amazed. They answer no more. They don't have a word to say. ¹⁶Shall I wait, because they don't speak, because they stand still, and answer no more? ¹⁷I also will answer my part, and I also will show my opinion. ¹⁸For I am full of words. The spirit within me constrains me. ¹⁹Behold, my breast is as wine which has no vent; like new wineskins it is ready to burst. ²⁰I will speak, that I may be refreshed. I will open my lips and answer. ²¹Please don't let me respect any man's person, neither will I give flattering titles to any man. ²²For I don't know how to give flattering titles, or else my Maker would soon take me away.

33 "However, Job, please hear my speech, and listen to all my words. ²See now, I have opened my mouth. My tongue has spoken in my mouth. ³My words will utter the uprightness of my heart. That which my lips know they will speak sincerely. ⁴The Spirit of God has made me, and the breath of the Almighty gives me life. ⁵If you can, answer me. Set your words in order before me, and stand up. ⁶Behold, I am toward God even as you are. I am also formed out of the clay. ⁷Behold, my terror will not make you afraid, neither will my pressure be heavy on

^{xvi}or, breath

you. ⁸“Surely you have spoken in my hearing, I have heard the voice of your words, saying, ⁹‘I am clean, without disobedience. I am innocent, neither is there iniquity in me. ¹⁰Behold, he finds occasions against me. He counts me for his enemy. ¹¹He puts my feet in the stocks. He marks all my paths.’ ¹²“Behold, I will answer you. In this you are not just, for God is greater than man. ¹³Why do you strive against him, because he doesn’t give account of any of his matters? ¹⁴For God speaks once, yes twice, though man pays no attention. ¹⁵In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falls on men, in slumbering on the bed, ¹⁶then he opens the ears of men, and seals their instruction, ¹⁷that he may withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man. ¹⁸He keeps back his soul from the pit, and his life from perishing by the sword. ¹⁹“He is chastened also with pain on his bed, with continual strife in his bones, ²⁰so that his life abhors bread, and his soul dainty food. ²¹His flesh is so consumed away that it can’t be seen. His bones that were not seen stick out. ²²Yes, his soul draws near to the pit, and his life to the destroyers. ²³“If there is beside him an angel, an interpreter, one among a thousand, to show to man what is right for him, ²⁴then God is gracious to him, and says, ‘Deliver him from going down to the pit, I have found a ransom.’ ²⁵His flesh will be fresher than a child’s. He returns to the days of his youth. ²⁶He prays to God, and he is favorable to him, so that he sees his face with joy. He restores to man his righteousness. ²⁷He sings before men, and says, ‘I have sinned, and perverted that which was right, and it didn’t profit me. ²⁸He has redeemed my soul from going into the pit. My life will see the light.’ ²⁹“Behold, God does all these things, twice, yes three times, with a man, ³⁰to bring back his soul from the pit, that he may be enlightened with the light of the living. ³¹Mark well, Job, and listen to me. Hold your peace, and I will speak. ³²If you have anything to say, answer me. Speak, for I desire to justify you. ³³If not, listen to me. Hold your peace, and I will teach you wisdom.”

34Moreover Elihu answered, ²“Hear my words, you wise men. Give ear to me, you who have knowledge. ³For the ear tries words, as the palate tastes food. ⁴Let us choose for us that which is right. Let us know among ourselves what is good. ⁵For Job has said, ‘I am righteous, God has taken away my right. ⁶Notwithstanding my right I am considered a liar. My wound is incurable, though I am without disobedience.’ ⁷What man is like Job, who drinks scorn like water, ⁸who goes in company with the workers of iniquity, and walks with wicked men? ⁹For he has said, ‘It profits a man nothing that he should delight himself with God.’ ¹⁰“Therefore listen to me, you men of understanding: far be it from God, that he should do wickedness, from the Almighty, that he should commit iniquity. ¹¹For the work of a man he will render to him,

and cause every man to find according to his ways. ¹²Yes surely, God will not do wickedly, neither will the Almighty pervert justice. ¹³Who put him in charge of the earth? Or who has appointed him over the whole world? ¹⁴If he set his heart on himself, if he gathered to himself his spirit and his breath, ¹⁵all flesh would perish together, and man would turn again to dust. ¹⁶“If now you have understanding, hear this. Listen to the voice of my words. ¹⁷Should even one who hates justice govern? Will you condemn him who is righteous and mighty, ¹⁸who says to a king, ‘Vile!’ or to nobles, ‘Wicked!’? ¹⁹He doesn’t respect the persons of princes, nor respect the rich more than the poor, for they all are the work of his hands. ²⁰In a moment they die, even at midnight. The people are shaken and pass away. The mighty are taken away without a hand. ²¹“For his eyes are on the ways of a man. He sees all his goings. ²²There is no darkness, nor thick gloom, where the workers of iniquity may hide themselves. ²³For he doesn’t need to consider a man further, that he should go before God in judgment. ²⁴He breaks mighty men in pieces in ways past finding out, and sets others in their place. ²⁵Therefore he takes knowledge of their works. He overturns them in the night, so that they are destroyed. ²⁶He strikes them as wicked men in the open sight of others; ²⁷because they turned away from following him, and wouldn’t pay attention to any of his ways, ²⁸so that they caused the cry of the poor to come to him. He heard the cry of the afflicted. ²⁹When he gives quietness, who then can condemn? When he hides his face, who then can see him? He is over a nation or a man alike, ³⁰that the godless man may not reign, that there be no one to ensnare the people. ³¹“For has any said to God, ‘I am guilty, but I will not offend any more. ³²Teach me that which I don’t see. If I have done iniquity, I will do it no more’? ³³Shall his recompense be as you desire, that you refuse it? For you must choose, and not I. Therefore speak what you know. ³⁴Men of understanding will tell me, yes, every wise man who hears me: ³⁵‘Job speaks without knowledge. His words are without wisdom.’ ³⁶I wish that Job were tried to the end, because of his answering like wicked men. ³⁷For he adds rebellion to his sin. He claps his hands among us, and multiplies his words against God.”

35Moreover Elihu answered, ²“Do you think this to be your right, or do you say, ‘My righteousness is more than God’s,’ ³that you ask, ‘What advantage will it be to you? What profit will I have, more than if I had sinned?’ ⁴I will answer you, and your companions with you. ⁵Look to the skies, and see. See the skies, which are higher than you. ⁶If you have sinned, what effect do you have against him? If your transgressions are multiplied, what do you do to him? ⁷If you are righteous, what do you give him? Or what does he receive from your hand? ⁸Your wickedness may hurt a man as you are, and your righteousness may profit a son

of man. ⁹“By reason of the multitude of oppressions they cry out. They cry for help by reason of the arm of the mighty. ¹⁰But no one says, ‘Where is God my Maker, who gives songs in the night, ¹¹who teaches us more than the animals of the earth, and makes us wiser than the birds of the sky?’ ¹²There they cry, but no one answers, because of the pride of evil men. ¹³Surely God will not hear an empty cry, neither will the Almighty regard it. ¹⁴How much less when you say you don’t see him. The cause is before him, and you wait for him! ¹⁵But now, because he has not visited in his anger, neither does he greatly regard arrogance, ¹⁶therefore Job opens his mouth with empty talk, and he multiplies words without knowledge.”

36 Elihu also continued, and said, ²“Bear with me a little, and I will show you; for I still have something to say on God’s behalf. ³I will get my knowledge from afar, and will ascribe righteousness to my Maker. ⁴For truly my words are not false. One who is perfect in knowledge is with you. ⁵“Behold, God is mighty, and doesn’t despise anyone. He is mighty in strength of understanding. ⁶He doesn’t preserve the life of the wicked, but gives justice to the afflicted. ⁷He doesn’t withdraw his eyes from the righteous, but with kings on the throne, he sets them forever, and they are exalted. ⁸If they are bound in fetters, and are taken in the cords of afflictions, ⁹then he shows them their work, and their transgressions, that they have behaved themselves proudly. ¹⁰He also opens their ears to instruction, and commands that they return from iniquity. ¹¹If they listen and serve him, they will spend their days in prosperity, and their years in pleasures. ¹²But if they don’t listen, they will perish by the sword; they will die without knowledge. ¹³“But those who are godless in heart lay up anger. They don’t cry for help when he binds them. ¹⁴They die in youth. Their life perishes among the unclean. ¹⁵He delivers the afflicted by their affliction, and opens their ear in oppression. ¹⁶Yes, he would have allured you out of distress, into a wide place, where there is no restriction. That which is set on your table would be full of fatness. ¹⁷“But you are full of the judgment of the wicked. Judgment and justice take hold of you. ¹⁸Don’t let riches entice you to wrath, neither let the great size of a bribe turn you aside. ¹⁹Would your wealth sustain you in distress, or all the might of your strength? ²⁰Don’t desire the night, when people are cut off in their place. ²¹Take heed, don’t regard iniquity; for you have chosen this rather than affliction. ²²Behold, God is exalted in his power. Who is a teacher like him? ²³Who has prescribed his way for him? Or who can say, ‘You have committed unrighteousness?’ ²⁴“Remember that you magnify his work, about which men have sung. ²⁵All men have looked on it. Man sees it afar off. ²⁶Behold, God is great, and we don’t know him. The number of his years is unsearchable. ²⁷For he draws up the drops of water, which distill in rain from

his vapor, ²⁸which the skies pour down and which drop on man abundantly. ²⁹Indeed, can anyone understand the spreading of the clouds and the thunderings of his pavilion? ³⁰Behold, he spreads his light around him. He covers the bottom of the sea. ³¹For by these he judges the people. He gives food in abundance. ³²He covers his hands with the lightning, and commands it to strike the mark. ³³Its noise tells about him, and the livestock also, concerning the storm that comes up.

37 “Yes, at this my heart trembles, and is moved out of its place. ²Hear, oh, hear the noise of his voice, the sound that goes out of his mouth. ³He sends it out under the whole sky, and his lightning to the ends of the earth. ⁴After it a voice roars. He thunders with the voice of his majesty. He doesn’t hold back anything when his voice is heard. ⁵God thunders marvelously with his voice. He does great things, which we can’t comprehend. ⁶For he says to the snow, ‘Fall on the earth,’ likewise to the shower of rain, and to the showers of his mighty rain. ⁷He seals up the hand of every man, that all men whom he has made may know it. ⁸Then the animals take cover, and remain in their dens. ⁹Out of its room comes the storm, and cold out of the north. ¹⁰By the breath of God, ice is given, and the width of the waters is frozen. ¹¹Yes, he loads the thick cloud with moisture. He spreads abroad the cloud of his lightning. ¹²It is turned around by his guidance, that they may do whatever he commands them on the surface of the habitable world, ¹³whether it is for correction, or for his land, or for loving kindness, that he causes it to come. ¹⁴“Listen to this, Job. Stand still, and consider the wondrous works of God. ¹⁵Do you know how God controls them, and causes the lightning of his cloud to shine? ¹⁶Do you know the workings of the clouds, the wondrous works of him who is perfect in knowledge? ¹⁷You whose clothing is warm when the earth is still by reason of the south wind? ¹⁸Can you, with him, spread out the sky, which is strong as a cast metal mirror? ¹⁹Teach us what we will tell him, for we can’t make our case by reason of darkness. ²⁰Will it be told him that I would speak? Or should a man wish that he were swallowed up? ²¹Now men don’t see the light which is bright in the skies, but the wind passes, and clears them. ²²Out of the north comes golden splendor. With God is awesome majesty. ²³We can’t reach the Almighty. He is exalted in power. In justice and great righteousness, he will not oppress. ²⁴Therefore men revere him. He doesn’t regard any who are wise of heart.”

38 Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind, ²“Who is this who darkens counsel by words without knowledge? ³Brace yourself like a man, for I will question you, then you answer me! ⁴“Where were you when I laid the foundations of the earth? Declare, if you have understanding. ⁵Who determined its measures, if you know? Or

who stretched the line on it? ⁶What were its foundations fastened on? Or who laid its cornerstone, ⁷when the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy? ⁸Or who shut up the sea with doors, when it broke out of the womb, ⁹when I made clouds its garment, and wrapped it in thick darkness, ¹⁰marked out for it my bound, set bars and doors, ¹¹and said, 'You may come here, but no further. Your proud waves shall be stopped here'? ¹²'Have you commanded the morning in your days, and caused the dawn to know its place, ¹³that it might take hold of the ends of the earth, and shake the wicked out of it? ¹⁴It is changed as clay under the seal, and presented as a garment. ¹⁵From the wicked, their light is withheld. The high arm is broken. ¹⁶'Have you entered into the springs of the sea? Or have you walked in the recesses of the deep? ¹⁷Have the gates of death been revealed to you? Or have you seen the gates of the shadow of death? ¹⁸Have you comprehended the earth in its width? Declare, if you know it all. ¹⁹'What is the way to the dwelling of light? As for darkness, where is its place, ²⁰that you should take it to its bound, that you should discern the paths to its house? ²¹Surely you know, for you were born then, and the number of your days is great! ²²Have you entered the storehouses of the snow, or have you seen the storehouses of the hail, ²³which I have reserved against the time of trouble, against the day of battle and war? ²⁴By what way is the lightning distributed, or the east wind scattered on the earth? ²⁵Who has cut a channel for the flood water, or the path for the thunderstorm, ²⁶to cause it to rain on a land where there is no man, on the wilderness, in which there is no man, ²⁷to satisfy the waste and desolate ground, to cause the tender grass to grow? ²⁸Does the rain have a father? Or who fathers the drops of dew? ²⁹Whose womb did the ice come out of? Who has given birth to the gray frost of the sky? ³⁰The waters become hard like stone, when the surface of the deep is frozen. ³¹'Can you bind the cluster of the Pleiades, or loosen the cords of Orion? ³²Can you lead the constellations out in their season? Or can you guide the Bear with her cubs? ³³Do you know the laws of the heavens? Can you establish its dominion over the earth? ³⁴'Can you lift up your voice to the clouds, that abundance of waters may cover you? ³⁵Can you send out lightnings, that they may go? Do they report to you, 'Here we are'? ³⁶Who has put wisdom in the inward parts? Or who has given understanding to the mind? ³⁷Who can count the clouds by wisdom? Or who can pour out the containers of the sky, ³⁸when the dust runs into a mass, and the clods of earth stick together? ³⁹'Can you hunt the prey for the lioness, or satisfy the appetite of the young lions, ⁴⁰when they crouch in their dens, and lie in wait in the thicket? ⁴¹Who provides for the raven his prey, when his young ones cry to God, and wander for lack of food?

39"Do you know the time when the mountain goats give

birth? Do you watch when the doe bears fawns? ²Can you count the months that they fulfill? Or do you know the time when they give birth? ³They bow themselves. They bear their young. They end their labor pains. ⁴Their young ones become strong. They grow up in the open field. They go out, and don't return again. ⁵'Who has set the wild donkey free? Or who has loosened the bonds of the swift donkey, ⁶whose home I have made the wilderness, and the salt land his dwelling place? ⁷He scorns the tumult of the city, neither does he hear the shouting of the driver. ⁸The range of the mountains is his pasture. He searches after every green thing. ⁹'Will the wild ox be content to serve you? Or will he stay by your feeding trough? ¹⁰Can you hold the wild ox in the furrow with his harness? Or will he till the valleys after you? ¹¹Will you trust him, because his strength is great? Or will you leave to him your labor? ¹²Will you confide in him, that he will bring home your seed, and gather the grain of your threshing floor? ¹³'The wings of the ostrich wave proudly, but are they the feathers and plumage of love? ¹⁴For she leaves her eggs on the earth, warms them in the dust, ¹⁵and forgets that the foot may crush them, or that the wild animal may trample them. ¹⁶She deals harshly with her young ones, as if they were not hers. Though her labor is in vain, she is without fear, ¹⁷because God has deprived her of wisdom, neither has he imparted to her understanding. ¹⁸When she lifts up herself on high, she scorns the horse and his rider. ¹⁹'Have you given the horse might? Have you clothed his neck with a quivering mane? ²⁰Have you made him to leap as a locust? The glory of his snorting is awesome. ²¹He paws in the valley, and rejoices in his strength. He goes out to meet the armed men. ²²He mocks at fear, and is not dismayed, neither does he turn back from the sword. ²³The quiver rattles against him, the flashing spear and the javelin. ²⁴He eats up the ground with fierceness and rage, neither does he stand still at the sound of the shofar. ²⁵As often as the shofar sounds he snorts, 'Aha!' He smells the battle afar off, the thunder of the captains, and the shouting. ²⁶'Is it by your wisdom that the hawk soars, and stretches her wings toward the south? ²⁷Is it at your command that the eagle mounts up, and makes his nest on high? ²⁸On the cliff he dwells and makes his home, on the point of the cliff and the stronghold. ²⁹From there he spies out the prey. His eyes see it afar off. ³⁰His young ones also suck up blood. Where the slain are, there he is."

40Moreover the LORD answered Job, ²"Shall he who argues contend with the Almighty? He who argues with God, let him answer it." ³Then Job answered the LORD, ⁴"Behold, I am of small account. What will I answer you? I lay my hand on my mouth. ⁵I have spoken once, and I will not answer; Yes, twice, but I will proceed no further." ⁶Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind: ⁷"Now brace yourself like a man. I will question

you, and you will answer me. ⁸Will you even annul my judgment? Will you condemn me, that you may be justified? ⁹Or do you have an arm like God? Can you thunder with a voice like him? ¹⁰“Now deck yourself with excellency and dignity. Array yourself with honor and majesty. ¹¹Pour out the fury of your anger. Look at everyone who is proud, and bring him low. ¹²Look at everyone who is proud, and humble him. Crush the wicked in their place. ¹³Hide them in the dust together. Bind their faces in the hidden place. ¹⁴Then I will also admit to you that your own right hand can save you. ¹⁵“See now behemoth, which I made as well as you. He eats grass as an ox. ¹⁶Look now, his strength is in his thighs. His force is in the muscles of his belly. ¹⁷He moves his tail like a cedar. The sinews of his thighs are knit together. ¹⁸His bones are like tubes of bronze. His limbs are like bars of iron. ¹⁹He is the chief of the ways of God. He who made him gives him his sword. ²⁰Surely the mountains produce food for him, where all the animals of the field play. ²¹He lies under the lotus trees, in the covert of the reed, and the marsh. ²²The lotuses cover him with their shade. The willows of the brook surround him. ²³Behold, if a river overflows, he doesn’t tremble. He is confident, though the Jordan swells even to his mouth. ²⁴Shall any take him when he is on the watch, or pierce through his nose with a snare?

⁴¹“Can you draw out Leviathan ^{xvii} with a fish hook, or press down his tongue with a cord? ²Can you put a rope into his nose, or pierce his jaw through with a hook? ³Will he make many petitions to you, or will he speak soft words to you? ⁴Will he make a covenant with you, that you should take him for a servant forever? ⁵Will you play with him as with a bird? Or will you bind him for your girls? ⁶Will traders barter for him? Will they part him among the merchants? ⁷Can you fill his skin with barbed irons, or his head with fish spears? ⁸Lay your hand on him. Remember the battle, and do so no more. ⁹Behold, the hope of him is in vain. Won’t one be cast down even at the sight of him? ¹⁰None is so fierce that he dare stir him up. Who then is he who can stand before me? ¹¹Who has first given to me, that I should repay him? Everything under the heavens is mine. ¹²“I will not keep silence concerning his limbs, nor his mighty strength, nor his goodly frame. ¹³Who can strip off his outer garment? Who will come within his jaws? ¹⁴Who can open the doors of his face? Around his teeth is terror. ¹⁵Strong scales are his pride, shut up together with a close seal. ¹⁶One is so near to another, that no air can come between them. ¹⁷They are joined to one another. They stick together, so that they can’t be pulled apart. ¹⁸His sneezing flashes out light. His eyes are like the eyelids of the morning. ¹⁹Out of his mouth go burning torches. Sparks of fire leap out. ²⁰Out of his nostrils a smoke goes, as of a boiling pot over

a fire of reeds. ²¹His breath kindles coals. A flame goes out of his mouth. ²²There is strength in his neck. Terror dances before him. ²³The flakes of his flesh are joined together. They are firm on him. They can’t be moved. ²⁴His heart is as firm as a stone, yes, firm as the lower millstone. ²⁵When he raises himself up, the mighty are afraid. They retreat before his thrashing. ²⁶If one attacks him with the sword, it can’t prevail; nor the spear, the dart, nor the pointed shaft. ²⁷He counts iron as straw, and bronze as rotten wood. ²⁸The arrow can’t make him flee. Sling stones are like chaff to him. ²⁹Clubs are counted as stubble. He laughs at the rushing of the javelin. ³⁰His undersides are like sharp potsherds, leaving a trail in the mud like a threshing sledge. ³¹He makes the deep to boil like a pot. He makes the sea like a pot of ointment. ³²He makes a path shine after him. One would think the deep had white hair. ³³On earth there is not his equal, that is made without fear. ³⁴He sees everything that is high. He is king over all the sons of pride.”

⁴²Then Job answered the LORD: ²“I know that you can do all things, and that no purpose of yours can be restrained. ³You asked, ‘Who is this who hides counsel without knowledge?’ therefore I have uttered that which I didn’t understand, things too wonderful for me, which I didn’t know. ⁴You said, ‘Listen, now, and I will speak; I will question you, and you will answer me.’ ⁵I had heard of you by the hearing of the ear, but now my eye sees you. ⁶Therefore I abhor myself, and repent in dust and ashes.” ⁷It was so, that after the LORD had spoken these words to Job, the LORD said to Eliphaz the Temanite, “My wrath is kindled against you, and against your two friends; for you have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job has. ⁸Now therefore, take to yourselves seven bulls and seven rams, and go to my servant Job, and offer up for yourselves a burnt offering; and my servant Job shall pray for you, for I will accept him, that I not deal with you according to your folly. For you have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job has.” ⁹So Eliphaz the Temanite and Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite went and did what the LORD commanded them, and the LORD accepted Job. ¹⁰The LORD restored Job’s prosperity when he prayed for his friends. The LORD gave Job twice as much as he had before. ¹¹Then all his brothers, all his sisters, and all those who had been of his acquaintance before, came to him and ate bread with him in his house. They comforted him, and consoled him concerning all the evil that the LORD had brought on him. Everyone also gave him a piece of money, ^{xviii} and everyone a ring of gold. ¹²So the LORD blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning. He had fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, one thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand female donkeys. ¹³He had also

^{xvii}Leviathan is a name for a crocodile or similar creature.

^{xviii}literally, kesitah, a unit of money, probably silver

seven sons and three daughters. ¹⁴He called the name of the first, Jemimah; and the name of the second, Keziah; and the name of the third, Keren Happuch. ¹⁵In all the land were no women found so beautiful as the daughters of Job. Their father gave them an inheritance among their brothers. ¹⁶After this Job lived one hundred forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons' sons, to four generations. ¹⁷So Job died, being old and full of days.

Psalms

¹Blessed is the man who doesn't walk in the counsel of the wicked, nor stand on the path of sinners, nor sit in the seat of scoffers; ²but his delight is in the LORD's ⁱ law. On his Torah he meditates day and night. ³He will be like a tree planted by the streams of water, that produces its fruit in its season, whose leaf also does not wither. Whatever he does shall prosper. ⁴The wicked are not so, but are like the chaff which the wind drives away. ⁵Therefore the wicked shall not stand in the judgment, nor sinners in the congregation of the righteous. ⁶For the LORD knows the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked shall perish.

²Why do the nations rage, and the peoples plot a vain thing? ²The kings of the earth take a stand, and the rulers take counsel together, against the LORD, and against his Anointed, ⁱⁱ saying, ³"Let's break their bonds apart, and cast their cords from us." ⁴He who sits in the heavens will laugh. The Lord ⁱⁱⁱ will have them in derision. ⁵Then he will speak to them in his anger, and terrify them in his wrath: ⁶"Yet I have set my King on my holy hill of Zion." ⁷I will tell of the decree: The LORD said to me, "You are my son. Today I have become your father. ⁸Ask of me, and I will give the nations for your inheritance, the uttermost parts of the earth for your possession. ⁹You shall break them with a rod of iron. You shall dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel." ¹⁰Now therefore be wise, you kings. Be instructed, you judges of the earth. ¹¹Serve the LORD with fear, and rejoice with trembling. ¹²Give sincere homage to the Son, ^{iv} lest he be angry, and you perish on the way, for his wrath will soon be kindled. Blessed are all those who take refuge in him.

³LORD, how my adversaries have increased! Many are those who rise up against me. ²Many there are who say of my soul, "There is no help for him in God." ^v ³But you, LORD, are a shield around me, my glory, and the one who

lifts up my head. ⁴I cry to the LORD with my voice, and he answers me out of his holy hill. ⁵I laid myself down and slept. I awakened, for the LORD sustains me. ⁶I will not be afraid of tens of thousands of people who have set themselves against me on every side. ⁷Arise, LORD! Save me, my God! For you have struck all of my enemies on the cheek bone. You have broken the teeth of the wicked. ⁸Salvation belongs to the LORD. May your blessing be on your people.

⁴Answer me when I call, God of my righteousness. Give me relief from my distress. Have mercy on me, and hear my prayer. ²You sons of men, how long shall my glory be turned into dishonor? Will you love vanity and seek after falsehood? ³But know that the LORD has set apart for himself him who is godly; The LORD will hear when I call to him. ⁴Stand in awe, and don't sin. Search your own heart on your bed, and be still. ⁵Offer the sacrifices of righteousness. Put your trust in the LORD. ⁶Many say, "Who will show us any good?" LORD, let the light of your face shine on us. ⁷You have put gladness in my heart, more than when their grain and their new wine are increased. ⁸In peace I will both lay myself down and sleep, for you alone, the LORD, make me live in safety.

⁵Give ear to my words, LORD. Consider my meditation. ²Listen to the voice of my cry, my King and my God, for I pray to you. ³LORD, in the morning you will hear my voice. In the morning I will lay my requests before you, and will watch expectantly. ⁴For you are not a God who has pleasure in wickedness. Evil can't live with you. ⁵The arrogant will not stand in your sight. You hate all workers of iniquity. ⁶You will destroy those who speak lies. The LORD abhors the bloodthirsty and deceitful man. ⁷But as for me, in the abundance of your loving kindness I will come into your house. I will bow toward your holy temple in reverence of you. ⁸Lead me, LORD, in your righteousness because of my enemies. Make your way straight before my face. ⁹For there is no faithfulness in their mouth. Their heart is destruction. Their throat is an open tomb. They flatter with their tongue. ¹⁰Hold them guilty, God. Let them fall by their own counsels. Thrust them out in the multitude of their transgressions,

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe word "Anointed" is the same as the word for "Messiah" or "Christ"

ⁱⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{iv}or, Kiss the son

^vThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim."

for they have rebelled against you. ¹¹But let all those who take refuge in you rejoice. Let them always shout for joy, because you defend them. Let them also who love your name be joyful in you. ¹²For you will bless the righteous. LORD, you will surround him with favor as with a shield.

⁶LORD, don't rebuke me in your anger, neither discipline me in your wrath. ²Have mercy on me, LORD, for I am faint. LORD, heal me, for my bones are troubled. ³My soul is also in great anguish. But you, LORD—how long? ⁴Return, LORD. Deliver my soul, and save me for your loving kindness' sake. ⁵For in death there is no memory of you. In Sheol, ^{vi} who shall give you thanks? ⁶I am weary with my groaning. Every night I flood my bed. I drench my couch with my tears. ⁷My eye wastes away because of grief. It grows old because of all my adversaries. ⁸Depart from me, all you workers of iniquity, for the LORD has heard the voice of my weeping. ⁹The LORD has heard my supplication. The LORD accepts my prayer. ¹⁰May all my enemies be ashamed and dismayed. They shall turn back, they shall be disgraced suddenly.

⁷LORD, my God, I take refuge in you. Save me from all those who pursue me, and deliver me, ²lest they tear apart my soul like a lion, ripping it in pieces, while there is no one to deliver. ³LORD, my God, if I have done this, if there is iniquity in my hands, ⁴if I have rewarded evil to him who was at peace with me (yes, I have delivered him who without cause was my adversary), ⁵let the enemy pursue my soul, and overtake it; yes, let him tread my life down to the earth, and lay my glory in the dust. ⁶Arise, LORD, in your anger. Lift up yourself against the rage of my adversaries. Awake for me. You have commanded judgment. ⁷Let the congregation of the peoples surround you. Rule over them on high. ⁸The LORD administers judgment to the peoples. Judge me, LORD, according to my righteousness, and to my integrity that is in me. ⁹Oh let the wickedness of the wicked come to an end, but establish the righteous; their minds and hearts are searched by the righteous God. ¹⁰My shield is with God, who saves the upright in heart. ¹¹God is a righteous judge, yes, a God who has indignation every day. ¹²If a man doesn't repent, he will sharpen his sword; he has bent and strung his bow. ¹³He has also prepared for himself the instruments of death. He makes ready his flaming arrows. ¹⁴Behold, ^{vii} he travails with iniquity. Yes, he has conceived mischief, and brought out falsehood. ¹⁵He has dug a hole, and has fallen into the pit which he made. ¹⁶The trouble he causes shall return to his own head. His violence shall come down on the crown of his own head. ¹⁷I will give thanks to the

LORD according to his righteousness, and will sing praise to the name of the LORD Most High.

⁸LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name in all the earth! You have set your glory above the heavens! ²From the lips of babes and infants you have established strength, because of your adversaries, that you might silence the enemy and the avenger. ³When I consider your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and the stars, which you have ordained, ⁴what is man, that you think of him? What is the son of man, that you care for him? ⁵For you have made him a little lower than the angels, ^{viii} and crowned him with glory and honor. ⁶You make him ruler over the works of your hands. You have put all things under his feet: ⁷All sheep and cattle, yes, and the animals of the field, ⁸the birds of the sky, the fish of the sea, and whatever passes through the paths of the seas. ⁹LORD, our Lord, how majestic is your name in all the earth!

⁹I will give thanks to the LORD with my whole heart. I will tell of all your marvelous works. ²I will be glad and rejoice in you. I will sing praise to your name, O Most High. ³When my enemies turn back, they stumble and perish in your presence. ⁴For you have maintained my just cause. You sit on the throne judging righteously. ⁵You have rebuked the nations. You have destroyed the wicked. You have blotted out their name forever and ever. ⁶The enemy is overtaken by endless ruin. The very memory of the cities which you have overthrown has perished. ⁷But the LORD reigns forever. He has prepared his throne for judgment. ⁸He will judge the world in righteousness. He will administer judgment to the peoples in uprightness. ⁹The LORD will also be a high tower for the oppressed; a high tower in times of trouble. ¹⁰Those who know your name will put their trust in you, for you, LORD, have not forsaken those who seek you. ¹¹Sing praises to the LORD, who dwells in Zion, and declare among the people what he has done. ¹²For he who avenges blood remembers them. He doesn't forget the cry of the afflicted. ¹³Have mercy on me, LORD. See my affliction by those who hate me, and lift me up from the gates of death, ¹⁴that I may show all of your praise. I will rejoice in your salvation in the gates of the daughter of Zion. ¹⁵The nations have sunk down in the pit that they made. In the net which they hid, their own foot is taken. ¹⁶The LORD has made himself known. He has executed judgment. The wicked is snared by the work of his own hands. ¹⁷The wicked shall be turned back to Sheol, ^{ix} even all the nations that forget God. ¹⁸For the needy shall not always be forgotten, nor the hope of

^{vi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{vii}"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{viii}Hebrew: Elohim. The word Elohim, used here, usually means "God", but can also mean "gods", "princes", or "angels". The Septuagint reads "angels" here. See also the quote from the Septuagint in

^{ix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

the poor perish forever. ¹⁹Arise, LORD! Don't let man prevail. Let the nations be judged in your sight. ²⁰Put them in fear, LORD. Let the nations know that they are only men.

10Why do you stand far off, LORD? Why do you hide yourself in times of trouble? ²In arrogance, the wicked hunt down the weak. They are caught in the schemes that they devise. ³For the wicked boasts of his heart's cravings. He blesses the greedy and condemns the LORD. ⁴The wicked, in the pride of his face, has no room in his thoughts for God. ⁵His ways are prosperous at all times. He is arrogant, and your laws are far from his sight. As for all his adversaries, he sneers at them. ⁶He says in his heart, "I shall not be shaken. For generations I shall have no trouble." ⁷His mouth is full of cursing, deceit, and oppression. Under his tongue is mischief and iniquity. ⁸He lies in wait near the villages. From ambushes, he murders the innocent. His eyes are secretly set against the helpless. ⁹He lurks in secret as a lion in his ambush. He lies in wait to catch the helpless. He catches the helpless when he draws him in his net. ¹⁰The helpless are crushed. They collapse. They fall under his strength. ¹¹He says in his heart, "God has forgotten. He hides his face. He will never see it." ¹²Arise, LORD! God, lift up your hand! Don't forget the helpless. ¹³Why does the wicked person condemn God, and say in his heart, "God won't call me into account?" ¹⁴But you do see trouble and grief. You consider it to take it into your hand. You help the victim and the fatherless. ¹⁵Break the arm of the wicked. As for the evil man, seek out his wickedness until you find none. ¹⁶The LORD is King forever and ever! The nations will perish out of his land. ¹⁷LORD, you have heard the desire of the humble. You will prepare their heart. You will cause your ear to hear, ¹⁸to judge the fatherless and the oppressed, that man who is of the earth may terrify no more.

11In the LORD, I take refuge. How can you say to my soul, "Flee as a bird to your mountain"? ²For, behold, the wicked bend their bows. They set their arrows on the strings, that they may shoot in darkness at the upright in heart. ³If the foundations are destroyed, what can the righteous do? ⁴The LORD is in his holy temple. The LORD is on his throne in heaven. His eyes observe. His eyes examine the children of men. ⁵The LORD examines the righteous, but his soul hates the wicked and him who loves violence. ⁶On the wicked he will rain blazing coals; fire, sulfur, and scorching wind shall be the portion of their cup. ⁷For the LORD is righteous. He loves righteousness. The upright shall see his face.

12Help, LORD; for the godly man ceases. For the faithful fail from among the children of men. ²Everyone lies to

his neighbor. They speak with flattering lips, and with a double heart. ³May the LORD cut off all flattering lips, and the tongue that boasts, ⁴who have said, "With our tongue we will prevail. Our lips are our own. Who is lord over us?" ⁵"Because of the oppression of the weak and because of the groaning of the needy, I will now arise," says the LORD; "I will set him in safety from those who malign him." ⁶The LORD's words are flawless words, as silver refined in a clay furnace, purified seven times. ⁷You will keep them, LORD. You will preserve them from this generation forever. ⁸The wicked walk on every side, when what is vile is exalted among the sons of men.

13How long, LORD? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? ²How long shall I take counsel in my soul, having sorrow in my heart every day? How long shall my enemy triumph over me? ³Behold, and answer me, LORD, my God. Give light to my eyes, lest I sleep in death; ⁴lest my enemy say, "I have prevailed against him;" lest my adversaries rejoice when I fall. ⁵But I trust in your loving kindness. My heart rejoices in your salvation. ⁶I will sing to the LORD, because he has been good to me.

14The fool has said in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt. They have done abominable deeds. There is no one who does good. ²The LORD looked down from heaven on the children of men, to see if there were any who understood, who sought after God. ³They have all gone aside. They have together become corrupt. There is no one who does good, no, not one. ⁴Have all the workers of iniquity no knowledge, who eat up my people as they eat bread, and don't call on the LORD? ⁵There they were in great fear, for God is in the generation of the righteous. ⁶You frustrate the plan of the poor, because the LORD is his refuge. ⁷Oh that the salvation [yeshuat] of Israel would come out of Zion! When the LORD restores the fortunes of his people, then Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.

15LORD, who shall dwell in your sanctuary? Who shall live on your holy hill? ²He who walks blamelessly and does what is right, and speaks truth in his heart; ³he who doesn't slander with his tongue, nor does evil to his friend, nor casts slurs against his fellow man; ⁴in whose eyes a vile man is despised, but who honors those who fear the LORD; he who keeps an oath even when it hurts, and doesn't change; ⁵he who doesn't lend out his money for usury, nor take a bribe against the innocent. He who does these things shall never be shaken.

16Preserve me, God, for I take refuge in you. ²My soul, you have said to the LORD, "You are my Lord. Apart from you I have no good thing." ³As for the holy ones

who are in the earth, they are the excellent ones in whom is all my delight. ⁴Their sorrows shall be multiplied who give gifts to another god. Their drink offerings of blood I will not offer, nor take their names on my lips. ⁵The LORD assigned my portion and my cup. You made my lot secure. ⁶The lines have fallen to me in pleasant places. Yes, I have a good inheritance. ⁷I will bless the LORD, who has given me counsel. Yes, my heart instructs me in the night seasons. ⁸I have set the LORD always before me. Because he is at my right hand, I shall not be moved. ⁹Therefore my heart is glad, and my tongue rejoices. My body shall also dwell in safety. ¹⁰For you will not leave my soul in Sheol, ^x neither will you allow your holy one to see corruption. ¹¹You will show me the path of life. In your presence is fullness of joy. In your right hand there are pleasures forever more.

17Hear, LORD, my righteous plea. Give ear to my prayer that doesn't go out of deceitful lips. ²Let my sentence come out of your presence. Let your eyes look on equity. ³You have proved my heart. You have visited me in the night. You have tried me, and found nothing. I have resolved that my mouth shall not disobey. ⁴As for the deeds of men, by the word of your lips, I have kept myself from the ways of the violent. ⁵My steps have held fast to your paths. My feet have not slipped. ⁶I have called on you, for you will answer me, God. Turn your ear to me. Hear my speech. ⁷Show your marvelous loving kindness, you who save those who take refuge by your right hand from their enemies. ⁸Keep me as the apple of your eye. Hide me under the shadow of your wings, ⁹from the wicked who oppress me, my deadly enemies, who surround me. ¹⁰They close up their callous hearts. With their mouth they speak proudly. ¹¹They have now surrounded us in our steps. They set their eyes to cast us down to the earth. ¹²He is like a lion that is greedy of his prey, as it were a young lion lurking in secret places. ¹³Arise, LORD, confront him. Cast him down. Deliver my soul from the wicked by your sword, ¹⁴from men by your hand, LORD, from men of the world, whose portion is in this life. You fill the belly of your cherished ones. Your sons have plenty, and they store up wealth for their children. ¹⁵As for me, I shall see your face in righteousness. I shall be satisfied, when I awake, with seeing your form.

18I love you, LORD, my strength. ²The LORD is my rock, my fortress, and my deliverer; my God, my rock, in whom I take refuge; my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower. ³I call on the LORD, who is worthy to be praised; and I am saved from my enemies. ⁴The cords of death surrounded me. The floods of ungodliness made me afraid. ⁵The cords of Sheol ^{xi} were around me.

The snares of death came on me. ⁶In my distress I called on the LORD, and cried to my God. He heard my voice out of his temple. My cry before him came into his ears. ⁷Then the earth shook and trembled. The foundations also of the mountains quaked and were shaken, because he was angry. ⁸Smoke went out of his nostrils. Consuming fire came out of his mouth. Coals were kindled by it. ⁹He bowed the heavens also, and came down. Thick darkness was under his feet. ¹⁰He rode on a cherub, and flew. Yes, he soared on the wings of the wind. ¹¹He made darkness his hiding place, his pavilion around him, darkness of waters, thick clouds of the skies. ¹²At the brightness before him his thick clouds passed, hailstones and coals of fire. ¹³The LORD also thundered in the sky. The Most High uttered his voice: hailstones and coals of fire. ¹⁴He sent out his arrows, and scattered them. He routed them with great lightning bolts. ¹⁵Then the channels of waters appeared. The foundations of the world were laid bare at your rebuke, LORD, at the blast of the breath of your nostrils. ¹⁶He sent from on high. He took me. He drew me out of many waters. ¹⁷He delivered me from my strong enemy, from those who hated me; for they were too mighty for me. ¹⁸They came on me in the day of my calamity, but the LORD was my support. ¹⁹He brought me out also into a large place. He delivered me, because he delighted in me. ²⁰The LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness. According to the cleanness of my hands, he has recompensed me. ²¹For I have kept the ways of the LORD, and have not wickedly departed from my God. ²²For all his ordinances were before me. I didn't put away his statutes from me. ²³I was also blameless with him. I kept myself from my iniquity. ²⁴Therefore the LORD has rewarded me according to my righteousness, according to the cleanness of my hands in his eyesight. ²⁵With the merciful you will show yourself merciful. With the perfect man, you will show yourself perfect. ²⁶With the pure, you will show yourself pure. With the crooked you will show yourself shrewd. ²⁷For you will save the afflicted people, but the arrogant eyes you will bring down. ²⁸For you will light my lamp, LORD. My God will light up my darkness. ²⁹For by you, I advance through a troop. By my God, I leap over a wall. ³⁰As for God, his way is perfect. The LORD's word is tried. He is a shield to all those who take refuge in him. ³¹For who is God, except the LORD? Who is a rock, besides our God, ³²the God who arms me with strength, and makes my way perfect? ³³He makes my feet like deer's feet, and sets me on my high places. ³⁴He teaches my hands to war, so that my arms bend a bow of bronze. ³⁵You have also given me the shield of your salvation. Your right hand sustains me. Your gentleness has made me great. ³⁶You have enlarged my steps under me, My feet have not slipped. ³⁷I will pursue my enemies, and overtake them. I won't turn away until they are consumed. ³⁸I will strike them through, so that they will not be able

^xSheol is the place of the dead.

^{xi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

to rise. They shall fall under my feet. ³⁹For you have armed me with strength to the battle. You have subdued under me those who rose up against me. ⁴⁰You have also made my enemies turn their backs to me, that I might cut off those who hate me. ⁴¹They cried, but there was no one to save; even to the LORD, but he didn't answer them. ⁴²Then I beat them small as the dust before the wind. I cast them out as the mire of the streets. ⁴³You have delivered me from the strivings of the people. You have made me the head of the nations. A people whom I have not known shall serve me. ⁴⁴As soon as they hear of me they shall obey me. The foreigners shall submit themselves to me. ⁴⁵The foreigners shall fade away, and shall come trembling out of their strongholds. ⁴⁶The LORD lives! Blessed be my rock. Exalted be the God of my salvation, ⁴⁷even the God who executes vengeance for me, and subdues peoples under me. ⁴⁸He rescues me from my enemies. Yes, you lift me up above those who rise up against me. You deliver me from the violent man. ⁴⁹Therefore I will give thanks to you, LORD, among the nations, and will sing praises to your name. ⁵⁰He gives great deliverance to his king, and shows loving kindness to his anointed, to David and to his offspring, ^{xii} forever more.

19 The heavens declare the glory of God. The expanse shows his handiwork. ²Day after day they pour out speech, and night after night they display knowledge. ³There is no speech nor language where their voice is not heard. ⁴Their voice has gone out through all the earth, their words to the end of the world. In them he has set a tent for the sun, ⁵which is as a bridegroom coming out of his room, like a strong man rejoicing to run his course. ⁶His going out is from the end of the heavens, his circuit to its ends. There is nothing hidden from its heat. ⁷The LORD's law is perfect, restoring the soul. The LORD's covenant is sure, making wise the simple. ⁸The LORD's precepts are right, rejoicing the heart. The LORD's commandment is pure, enlightening the eyes. ⁹The fear of the LORD is clean, enduring forever. The LORD's ordinances are true, and righteous altogether. ¹⁰They are more to be desired than gold, yes, than much fine gold, sweeter also than honey and the extract of the honeycomb. ¹¹Moreover your servant is warned by them. In keeping them there is great reward. ¹²Who can discern his errors? Forgive me from hidden errors. ¹³Keep back your servant also from presumptuous sins. Let them not have dominion over me. Then I will be upright. I will be blameless and innocent of great transgression. ¹⁴Let the words of my mouth and the meditation of my heart be acceptable in your sight, LORD, my rock, and my redeemer.

20 May the LORD answer you in the day of trouble. May the name of the God of Jacob set you up on high,

^{xii}or, seed

²send you help from the sanctuary, grant you support from Zion, ³remember all your offerings, and accept your burned sacrifice. ⁴May he grant you your heart's desire, and fulfill all your counsel. ⁵We will triumph in your salvation. In the name of our God, we will set up our banners. May the LORD grant all your requests. ⁶Now I know that the LORD saves his anointed. He will answer him from his holy heaven, with the saving strength of his right hand. ⁷Some trust in chariots, and some in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God. ⁸They are bowed down and fallen, but we rise up, and stand upright. ⁹Save, LORD! Let the King answer us when we call!

21 The king rejoices in your strength, LORD! How greatly he rejoices in your salvation! ²You have given him his heart's desire, and have not withheld the request of his lips. ³For you meet him with the blessings of goodness. You set a crown of fine gold on his head. ⁴He asked life of you and you gave it to him, even length of days forever and ever. ⁵His glory is great in your salvation. You lay honor and majesty on him. ⁶For you make him most blessed forever. You make him glad with joy in your presence. ⁷For the king trusts in the LORD. Through the loving kindness of the Most High, he shall not be moved. ⁸Your hand will find out all of your enemies. Your right hand will find out those who hate you. ⁹You will make them as a fiery furnace in the time of your anger. The LORD will swallow them up in his wrath. The fire shall devour them. ¹⁰You will destroy their descendants from the earth, their posterity from among the children of men. ¹¹For they intended evil against you. They plotted evil against you which cannot succeed. ¹²For you will make them turn their back, when you aim drawn bows at their face. ¹³Be exalted, LORD, in your strength, so we will sing and praise your power.

22 My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Why are you so far from helping me, and from the words of my groaning? ²My God, I cry in the daytime, but you don't answer; in the night season, and am not silent. ³But you are holy, you who inhabit the praises of Israel. ⁴Our fathers trusted in you. They trusted, and you delivered them. ⁵They cried to you, and were delivered. They trusted in you, and were not disappointed. ⁶But I am a worm, and no man; a reproach of men, and despised by the people. ⁷All those who see me mock me. They insult me with their lips. They shake their heads, saying, ⁸"He trusts in the LORD. Let him deliver him. Let him rescue him, since he delights in him." ⁹But you brought me out of the womb. You made me trust while at my mother's breasts. ¹⁰I was thrown on you from my mother's womb. You are my God since my mother bore me. ¹¹Don't be far from me, for trouble is near. For there is no one to help. ¹²Many bulls have surrounded me. Strong bulls of Bashan have encircled me. ¹³They open their mouths wide against me,

lions tearing prey and roaring. ¹⁴I am poured out like water. All my bones are out of joint. My heart is like wax. It is melted within me. ¹⁵My strength is dried up like a potsherd. My tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth. You have brought me into the dust of death. ¹⁶For dogs have surrounded me. A company of evildoers have enclosed me. They have pierced my hands and feet. ^{xiii} ¹⁷I can count all of my bones. They look and stare at me. ¹⁸They divide my garments among them. They cast lots for my clothing. ¹⁹But don't be far off, LORD. You are my help. Hurry to help me! ²⁰Deliver my soul from the sword, my precious life from the power of the dog. ²¹Save me from the lion's mouth! Yes, you have rescued me from the horns of the wild oxen. ²²I will declare your name to my brothers. Among the assembly, I will praise you. ²³You who fear the LORD, praise him! All you descendants of Jacob, glorify him! Stand in awe of him, all you descendants of Israel! ²⁴For he has not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted, Neither has he hidden his face from him; but when he cried to him, he heard. ²⁵My praise of you comes in the great assembly. I will pay my vows before those who fear him. ²⁶The humble shall eat and be satisfied. They shall praise the LORD who seek after him. Let your hearts live forever. ²⁷All the ends of the earth shall remember and turn to the LORD. All the relatives of the nations shall worship before you. ²⁸For the kingdom is the LORD's. He is the ruler over the nations. ²⁹All the rich ones of the earth shall eat and worship. All those who go down to the dust shall bow before him, even he who can't keep his soul alive. ³⁰Posterity shall serve him. Future generations shall be told about the Lord. ³¹They shall come and shall declare his righteousness to a people that shall be born, for he has done it.

23The LORD is my shepherd; I shall lack nothing. ²He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. ³He restores my soul. He guides me in the paths of righteousness for his name's sake. ⁴Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me. Your rod and your staff, they comfort me. ⁵You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil. My cup runs over. ⁶Surely goodness and loving kindness shall follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the LORD's house forever.

24The earth is the LORD's, with its fullness; the world, and those who dwell in it. ²For he has founded it on the seas, and established it on the floods. ³Who may ascend to the LORD's hill? Who may stand in his holy place? ⁴He who has clean hands and a pure heart; who has not lifted up his soul to falsehood, and has not sworn deceitfully.

^{xiii}So Dead Sea Scrolls. Masoretic Text reads, "Like a lion, they pin my hands and feet."

⁵He shall receive a blessing from the LORD, righteousness from the God of his salvation. ⁶This is the generation of those who seek Him, who seek your face—even Jacob. Selah. ⁷Lift up your heads, you gates! Be lifted up, you everlasting doors, and the King of glory will come in. ⁸Who is the King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, The LORD mighty in battle. ⁹Lift up your heads, you gates; yes, lift them up, you everlasting doors, and the King of glory will come in. ¹⁰Who is this King of glory? The LORD of Hosts is the King of glory! Selah.

25To you, LORD, I lift up my soul. ²My God, I have trusted in you. Don't let me be shamed. Don't let my enemies triumph over me. ³Yes, no one who waits for you will be shamed. They will be shamed who deal treacherously without cause. ⁴Show me your ways, LORD. Teach me your paths. ⁵Guide me in your truth, and teach me, For you are the God of my salvation. I wait for you all day long. ⁶LORD, remember your tender mercies and your loving kindness, for they are from old times. ⁷Don't remember the sins of my youth, nor my transgressions. Remember me according to your loving kindness, for your goodness' sake, LORD. ⁸Good and upright is the LORD, therefore he will instruct sinners in the way. ⁹He will guide the humble in justice. He will teach the humble his way. ¹⁰All the paths of the LORD are loving kindness and truth to such as keep his covenant and his testimonies. ¹¹For your name's sake, LORD, pardon my iniquity, for it is great. ¹²What man is he who fears the LORD? He shall instruct him in the way that he shall choose. ¹³His soul will dwell at ease. His offspring will inherit the land. ¹⁴The friendship of the LORD is with those who fear him. He will show them his covenant. ¹⁵My eyes are ever on the LORD, for he will pluck my feet out of the net. ¹⁶Turn to me, and have mercy on me, for I am desolate and afflicted. ¹⁷The troubles of my heart are enlarged. Oh bring me out of my distresses. ¹⁸Consider my affliction and my travail. Forgive all my sins. ¹⁹Consider my enemies, for they are many. They hate me with cruel hatred. ²⁰Oh keep my soul, and deliver me. Let me not be disappointed, for I take refuge in you. ²¹Let integrity and uprightness preserve me, for I wait for you. ²²God, redeem Israel out of all his troubles.

26Judge me, LORD, for I have walked in my integrity. I have trusted also in the LORD without wavering. ²Examine me, LORD, and prove me. Try my heart and my mind. ³For your loving kindness is before my eyes. I have walked in your truth. ⁴I have not sat with deceitful men, neither will I go in with hypocrites. ⁵I hate the assembly of evildoers, and will not sit with the wicked. ⁶I will wash my hands in innocence, so I will go about your altar, LORD, ⁷that I may make the voice of thanksgiving to be heard and tell of all your wondrous deeds. ⁸LORD, I love the habitation of your house, the place where your glory dwells. ⁹Don't

gather my soul with sinners, nor my life with bloodthirsty men ¹⁰in whose hands is wickedness; their right hand is full of bribes. ¹¹But as for me, I will walk in my integrity. Redeem me, and be merciful to me. ¹²My foot stands in an even place. In the congregations I will bless the LORD.

27The LORD is my light and my salvation. Whom shall I fear? The LORD is the strength of my life. Of whom shall I be afraid? ²When evildoers came at me to eat up my flesh, even my adversaries and my foes, they stumbled and fell. ³Though an army should encamp against me, my heart shall not fear. Though war should rise against me, even then I will be confident. ⁴One thing I have asked of the LORD, that I will seek after: that I may dwell in the LORD's house all the days of my life, to see the LORD's beauty, and to inquire in his temple. ⁵For in the day of trouble, he will keep me secretly in his pavilion. In the secret place of his tabernacle, he will hide me. He will lift me up on a rock. ⁶Now my head will be lifted up above my enemies around me. I will offer sacrifices of joy in his tent. I will sing, yes, I will sing praises to the LORD. ⁷Hear, LORD, when I cry with my voice. Have mercy also on me, and answer me. ⁸When you said, "Seek my face," my heart said to you, "I will seek your face, LORD." ⁹Don't hide your face from me. Don't put your servant away in anger. You have been my help. Don't abandon me, neither forsake me, God of my salvation. ¹⁰When my father and my mother forsake me, then the LORD will take me up. ¹¹Teach me your way, LORD. Lead me in a straight path, because of my enemies. ¹²Don't deliver me over to the desire of my adversaries, for false witnesses have risen up against me, such as breathe out cruelty. ¹³I am still confident of this: I will see the goodness of the LORD in the land of the living. ¹⁴Wait for the LORD. Be strong, and let your heart take courage. Yes, wait for the LORD.

28To you, LORD, I call. My rock, don't be deaf to me, lest, if you are silent to me, I would become like those who go down into the pit. ²Hear the voice of my petitions, when I cry to you, when I lift up my hands toward your Most Holy Place. ³Don't draw me away with the wicked, with the workers of iniquity who speak peace with their neighbors, but mischief is in their hearts. ⁴Give them according to their work, and according to the wickedness of their doings. Give them according to the operation of their hands. Bring back on them what they deserve. ⁵Because they don't respect the works of the LORD, nor the operation of his hands, he will break them down and not build them up. ⁶Blessed be the LORD, because he has heard the voice of my petitions. ⁷The LORD is my strength and my shield. My heart has trusted in him, and I am helped. Therefore my heart greatly rejoices. With my song I will thank him. ⁸The LORD is their strength. He is a stronghold of salvation to his anointed. ⁹Save your people, and bless

your inheritance. Be their shepherd also, and bear them up forever.

29Ascribe to the LORD, you sons of the mighty, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength. ²Ascribe to the LORD the glory due to his name. Worship the LORD in holy array. ³The LORD's voice is on the waters. The God of glory thunders, even the LORD on many waters. ⁴The LORD's voice is powerful. The LORD's voice is full of majesty. ⁵The LORD's voice breaks the cedars. Yes, the LORD breaks in pieces the cedars of Lebanon. ⁶He makes them also to skip like a calf; Lebanon and Sirion like a young, wild ox. ⁷The LORD's voice strikes with flashes of lightning. ⁸The LORD's voice shakes the wilderness. The LORD shakes the wilderness of Kadesh. ⁹The LORD's voice makes the deer calve, and strips the forests bare. In his temple everything says, "Glory!" ¹⁰The LORD sat enthroned at the Flood. Yes, the LORD sits as King forever. ¹¹The LORD will give strength to his people. The LORD will bless his people with peace.

30I will extol you, LORD, for you have raised me up, and have not made my foes to rejoice over me. ²LORD my God, I cried to you, and you have healed me. ³LORD, you have brought up my soul from Sheol. ^{xiv} You have kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit. ⁴Sing praise to the LORD, you holy ones of his. Give thanks to his holy name. ⁵For his anger is but for a moment. His favor is for a lifetime. Weeping may stay for the night, but joy comes in the morning. ⁶As for me, I said in my prosperity, "I shall never be moved." ⁷You, LORD, when you favored me, made my mountain stand strong; but when you hid your face, I was troubled. ⁸I cried to you, LORD. I made supplication to the Lord: ⁹"What profit is there in my destruction, if I go down to the pit? Shall the dust praise you? Shall it declare your truth?" ¹⁰Hear, LORD, and have mercy on me. LORD, be my helper." ¹¹You have turned my mourning into dancing for me. You have removed my sackcloth, and clothed me with gladness, ¹²to the end that my heart may sing praise to you, and not be silent. LORD my God, I will give thanks to you forever!

31In you, LORD, I take refuge. Let me never be disappointed. Deliver me in your righteousness. ²Bow down your ear to me. Deliver me speedily. Be to me a strong rock, a house of defense to save me. ³For you are my rock and my fortress, therefore for your name's sake lead me and guide me. ⁴Pluck me out of the net that they have laid secretly for me, for you are my stronghold. ⁵Into your hand I commend my spirit. You redeem me, LORD, God of truth. ⁶I hate those who regard lying vanities, but I trust in the LORD. ⁷I will be glad and rejoice in your loving kindness, for you have seen my affliction. You have

^{xiv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

known my soul in adversities. ⁸You have not shut me up into the hand of the enemy. You have set my feet in a large place. ⁹Have mercy on me, LORD, for I am in distress. My eye, my soul, and my body waste away with grief. ¹⁰For my life is spent with sorrow, my years with sighing. My strength fails because of my iniquity. My bones are wasted away. ¹¹Because of all my adversaries I have become utterly contemptible to my neighbors, a horror to my acquaintances. Those who saw me on the street fled from me. ¹²I am forgotten from their hearts like a dead man. I am like broken pottery. ¹³For I have heard the slander of many, terror on every side, while they conspire together against me, they plot to take away my life. ¹⁴But I trust in you, LORD. I said, "You are my God." ¹⁵My times are in your hand. Deliver me from the hand of my enemies, and from those who persecute me. ¹⁶Make your face to shine on your servant. Save me in your loving kindness. ¹⁷Let me not be disappointed, LORD, for I have called on you. Let the wicked be disappointed. Let them be silent in Sheol. ^{xv} ¹⁸Let the lying lips be mute, which speak against the righteous insolently, with pride and contempt. ¹⁹Oh how great is your goodness, which you have laid up for those who fear you, which you have worked for those who take refuge in you, before the sons of men! ²⁰In the shelter of your presence you will hide them from the plotting of man. You will keep them secretly in a dwelling away from the strife of tongues. ²¹Praise be to the LORD, for he has shown me his marvelous loving kindness in a strong city. ²²As for me, I said in my haste, "I am cut off from before your eyes." Nevertheless you heard the voice of my petitions when I cried to you. ²³Oh love the LORD, all you his holy ones! The LORD preserves the faithful, and fully recompenses him who behaves arrogantly. ²⁴Be strong, and let your heart take courage, all you who hope in the LORD.

32 Blessed is he whose disobedience is forgiven, whose sin is covered. ²Blessed is the man to whom the LORD doesn't impute iniquity, in whose spirit there is no deceit. ³When I kept silence, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long. ⁴For day and night your hand was heavy on me. My strength was sapped in the heat of summer. Selah. ⁵I acknowledged my sin to you. I didn't hide my iniquity. I said, I will confess my transgressions to the LORD, and you forgave the iniquity of my sin. Selah. ⁶For this, let everyone who is godly pray to you in a time when you may be found. Surely when the great waters overflow, they shall not reach to him. ⁷You are my hiding place. You will preserve me from trouble. You will surround me with songs of deliverance. Selah. ⁸I will instruct you and teach you in the way which you shall go. I will counsel you with my eye on you. ⁹Don't be like the horse, or like the mule, which have no understanding, who are controlled

by bit and bridle, or else they will not come near to you. ¹⁰Many sorrows come to the wicked, but loving kindness shall surround him who trusts in the LORD. ¹¹Be glad in the LORD, and rejoice, you righteous! Shout for joy, all you who are upright in heart!

33 Rejoice in the LORD, you righteous! Praise is fitting for the upright. ²Give thanks to the LORD with the lyre. Sing praises to him with the harp of ten strings. ³Sing to him a new song. Play skillfully with a shout of joy! ⁴For the LORD's word is right. All his work is done in faithfulness. ⁵He loves righteousness and justice. The earth is full of the loving kindness of the LORD. ⁶By the LORD's word, the heavens were made: all their army by the breath of his mouth. ⁷He gathers the waters of the sea together as a heap. He lays up the deeps in storehouses. ⁸Let all the earth fear the LORD. Let all the inhabitants of the world stand in awe of him. ⁹For he spoke, and it was done. He commanded, and it stood firm. ¹⁰The LORD brings the counsel of the nations to nothing. He makes the thoughts of the peoples to be of no effect. ¹¹The counsel of the LORD stands fast forever, the thoughts of his heart to all generations. ¹²Blessed is the nation whose God is the LORD, the people whom he has chosen for his own inheritance. ¹³The LORD looks from heaven. He sees all the sons of men. ¹⁴From the place of his habitation he looks out on all the inhabitants of the earth, ¹⁵he who fashions all of their hearts; and he considers all of their works. ¹⁶There is no king saved by the multitude of an army. A mighty man is not delivered by great strength. ¹⁷A horse is a vain thing for safety, neither does he deliver any by his great power. ¹⁸Behold, the LORD's eye is on those who fear him, on those who hope in his loving kindness, ¹⁹to deliver their soul from death, to keep them alive in famine. ²⁰Our soul has waited for the LORD. He is our help and our shield. ²¹For our heart rejoices in him, because we have trusted in his holy name. ²²Let your loving kindness be on us, LORD, since we have hoped in you.

34^{xvi} I will bless the LORD at all times. His praise will always be in my mouth. ²My soul shall boast in the LORD. The humble shall hear of it and be glad. ³Oh magnify the LORD with me. Let's exalt his name together. ⁴I sought the LORD, and he answered me, and delivered me from all my fears. ⁵They looked to him, and were radiant. Their faces shall never be covered with shame. ⁶This poor man cried, and the LORD heard him, and saved him out of all his troubles. ⁷The LORD's angel encamps around those who fear him, and delivers them. ⁸Oh taste and see that the LORD is good. Blessed is the man who takes refuge in him. ⁹Oh fear the LORD, you his holy ones, for there is no lack with those who fear him. ¹⁰The young lions

^{xv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xvi}Psalms 34 is an acrostic poem, with each verse starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav).

do lack, and suffer hunger, but those who seek the LORD shall not lack any good thing. ¹¹Come, you children, listen to me. I will teach you the fear of the LORD. ¹²Who is someone who desires life, and loves many days, that he may see good? ¹³Keep your tongue from evil, and your lips from speaking lies. ¹⁴Depart from evil, and do good. Seek peace, and pursue it. ¹⁵The LORD's eyes are toward the righteous. His ears listen to their cry. ¹⁶The LORD's face is against those who do evil, to cut off their memory from the earth. ¹⁷The righteous cry, and the LORD hears, and delivers them out of all their troubles. ¹⁸The LORD is near to those who have a broken heart, and saves those who have a crushed spirit. ¹⁹Many are the afflictions of the righteous, but the LORD delivers him out of them all. ²⁰He protects all of his bones. Not one of them is broken. ²¹Evil shall kill the wicked. Those who hate the righteous shall be condemned. ²²The LORD redeems the soul of his servants. None of those who take refuge in him shall be condemned.

35 Contend, LORD, with those who contend with me. Fight against those who fight against me. ²Take hold of shield and buckler, and stand up for my help. ³Brandish the spear and block those who pursue me. Tell my soul, "I am your salvation." ⁴Let those who seek after my soul be disappointed and brought to dishonor. Let those who plot my ruin be turned back and confounded. ⁵Let them be as chaff before the wind, The LORD's angel driving them on. ⁶Let their way be dark and slippery, The LORD's angel pursuing them. ⁷For without cause they have hidden their net in a pit for me. Without cause they have dug a pit for my soul. ⁸Let destruction come on him unawares. Let his net that he has hidden catch himself. Let him fall into that destruction. ⁹My soul shall be joyful in the LORD. It shall rejoice in his salvation. ¹⁰All my bones shall say, "LORD, who is like you, who delivers the poor from him who is too strong for him; yes, the poor and the needy from him who robs him?" ¹¹Unrighteous witnesses rise up. They ask me about things that I don't know about. ¹²They reward me evil for good, to the bereaving of my soul. ¹³But as for me, when they were sick, my clothing was sackcloth. I afflicted my soul with fasting. My prayer returned into my own bosom. ¹⁴I behaved myself as though it had been my friend or my brother. I bowed down mourning, as one who mourns his mother. ¹⁵But in my adversity, they rejoiced, and gathered themselves together. The attackers gathered themselves together against me, and I didn't know it. They tore at me, and didn't cease. ¹⁶Like the profane mockers in feasts, they gnashed their teeth at me. ¹⁷Lord, how long will you look on? Rescue my soul from their destruction, my precious life from the lions. ¹⁸I will give you thanks in the great assembly. I will praise you among many people. ¹⁹Don't let those who are my enemies wrongfully rejoice over me; neither let those who hate me without a cause

wink their eyes. ²⁰For they don't speak peace, but they devise deceitful words against those who are quiet in the land. ²¹Yes, they opened their mouth wide against me. They said, "Aha! Aha! Our eye has seen it!" ²²You have seen it, LORD. Don't keep silent. Lord, don't be far from me. ²³Wake up! Rise up to defend me, my God! My Lord, contend for me! ²⁴Vindicate me, LORD my God, according to your righteousness. Don't let them gloat over me. ²⁵Don't let them say in their heart, "Aha! That's the way we want it!" Don't let them say, "We have swallowed him up!" ²⁶Let them be disappointed and confounded together who rejoice at my calamity. Let them be clothed with shame and dishonor who magnify themselves against me. ²⁷Let those who favor my righteous cause shout for joy and be glad. Yes, let them say continually, "May The LORD be magnified, who has pleasure in the prosperity of his servant!" ²⁸My tongue shall talk about your righteousness and about your praise all day long.

36 A revelation is within my heart about the disobedience of the wicked: There is no fear of God before his eyes. ²For he flatters himself in his own eyes, too much to detect and hate his sin. ³The words of his mouth are iniquity and deceit. He has ceased to be wise and to do good. ⁴He plots iniquity on his bed. He sets himself in a way that is not good. He doesn't abhor evil. ⁵Your loving kindness, LORD, is in the heavens. Your faithfulness reaches to the skies. ⁶Your righteousness is like the mountains of God. Your judgments are like a great deep. LORD, you preserve man and animal. ⁷How precious is your loving kindness, God! The children of men take refuge under the shadow of your wings. ⁸They shall be abundantly satisfied with the abundance of your house. You will make them drink of the river of your pleasures. ⁹For with you is the spring of life. In your light we will see light. ¹⁰Oh continue your loving kindness to those who know you, your righteousness to the upright in heart. ¹¹Don't let the foot of pride come against me. Don't let the hand of the wicked drive me away. ¹²There the workers of iniquity are fallen. They are thrust down, and shall not be able to rise.

37 Don't fret because of evildoers, neither be envious against those who work unrighteousness. ²For they shall soon be cut down like the grass, and wither like the green herb. ³Trust in the LORD, and do good. Dwell in the land, and enjoy safe pasture. ⁴Also delight yourself in the LORD, and he will give you the desires of your heart. ⁵Commit your way to the LORD. Trust also in him, and he will do this: ⁶he will make your righteousness shine out like light, and your justice as the noon day sun. ⁷Rest in the LORD, and wait patiently for him. Don't fret because of him who prospers in his way, because of the man who makes wicked plots happen. ⁸Cease from anger, and forsake wrath. Don't fret; it leads only to evildoing. ⁹For evil-

doers shall be cut off, but those who wait for the LORD shall inherit the land. ¹⁰For yet a little while, and the wicked will be no more. Yes, though you look for his place, he isn't there. ¹¹But the humble shall inherit the land, and shall delight themselves in the abundance of peace. ¹²The wicked plots against the just, and gnashes at him with his teeth. ¹³The Lord will laugh at him, for he sees that his day is coming. ¹⁴The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow, to cast down the poor and needy, to kill those who are upright on the path. ¹⁵Their sword shall enter into their own heart. Their bows shall be broken. ¹⁶Better is a little that the righteous has, than the abundance of many wicked. ¹⁷For the arms of the wicked shall be broken, but the LORD upholds the righteous. ¹⁸The LORD knows the days of the perfect. Their inheritance shall be forever. ¹⁹They shall not be disappointed in the time of evil. In the days of famine they shall be satisfied. ²⁰But the wicked shall perish. The enemies of the LORD shall be like the beauty of the fields. They will vanish—vanish like smoke. ²¹The wicked borrow, and don't pay back, but the righteous give generously. ²²For such as are blessed by him shall inherit the land. Those who are cursed by him shall be cut off. ²³A man's steps are established by the LORD. He delights in his way. ²⁴Though he stumble, he shall not fall, for the LORD holds him up with his hand. ²⁵I have been young, and now am old, yet I have not seen the righteous forsaken, nor his children begging for bread. ²⁶All day long he deals graciously, and lends. His offspring is blessed. ²⁷Depart from evil, and do good. Live securely forever. ²⁸For the LORD loves justice, and doesn't forsake his holy ones. They are preserved forever, but the children of the wicked shall be cut off. ²⁹The righteous shall inherit the land, and live in it forever. ³⁰The mouth of the righteous talks of wisdom. His tongue speaks justice. ³¹The law of his God is in his heart. None of his steps shall slide. ³²The wicked watch the righteous, and seek to kill him. ³³The LORD will not leave him in his hand, nor condemn him when he is judged. ³⁴Wait for the LORD, and keep his way, and he will exalt you to inherit the land. When the wicked are cut off, you shall see it. ³⁵I have seen the wicked in great power, spreading himself like a green tree in its native soil. ³⁶But he passed away, and behold, he was not. Yes, I sought him, but he could not be found. ³⁷Mark the perfect man, and see the upright, for there is a future for the man of peace. ³⁸As for transgressors, they shall be destroyed together. The future of the wicked shall be cut off. ³⁹But the salvation of the righteous is from the LORD. He is their stronghold in the time of trouble. ⁴⁰The LORD helps them and rescues them. He rescues them from the wicked and saves them, because they have taken refuge in him.

38LORD, don't rebuke me in your wrath, neither chas-

ten me in your hot displeasure. ²For your arrows have pierced me, your hand presses hard on me. ³There is no soundness in my flesh because of your indignation, neither is there any health in my bones because of my sin. ⁴For my iniquities have gone over my head. As a heavy burden, they are too heavy for me. ⁵My wounds are loathsome and corrupt because of my foolishness. ⁶I am in pain and bowed down greatly. I go mourning all day long. ⁷For my waist is filled with burning. There is no soundness in my flesh. ⁸I am faint and severely bruised. I have groaned by reason of the anguish of my heart. ⁹Lord, all my desire is before you. My groaning is not hidden from you. ¹⁰My heart throbs. My strength fails me. As for the light of my eyes, it has also left me. ¹¹My lovers and my friends stand aloof from my plague. My kinsmen stand far away. ¹²They also who seek after my life lay snares. Those who seek my hurt speak mischievous things, and meditate deceptions all day long. ¹³But I, as a deaf man, don't hear. I am as a mute man who doesn't open his mouth. ¹⁴Yes, I am as a man who doesn't hear, in whose mouth are no reproaches. ¹⁵For I hope in you, LORD. You will answer, Lord my God. ¹⁶For I said, "Don't let them gloat over me, or exalt themselves over me when my foot slips." ¹⁷For I am ready to fall. My pain is continually before me. ¹⁸For I will declare my iniquity. I will be sorry for my sin. ¹⁹But my enemies are vigorous and many. Those who hate me without reason are numerous. ²⁰They who render evil for good are also adversaries to me, because I follow what is good. ²¹Don't forsake me, LORD. My God, don't be far from me. ²²Hurry to help me, Lord, my salvation.

39I said, "I will watch my ways, so that I don't sin with my tongue. I will keep my mouth with a bridle while the wicked is before me." ²I was mute with silence. I held my peace, even from good. My sorrow was stirred. ³My heart was hot within me. While I meditated, the fire burned. I spoke with my tongue: ⁴"LORD, show me my end, what is the measure of my days. Let me know how frail I am." ⁵Behold, you have made my days hand widths. My lifetime is as nothing before you. Surely every man stands as a breath." ⁶"Surely every man walks like a shadow. Surely they busy themselves in vain. He heaps up, and doesn't know who shall gather. ⁷Now, Lord, what do I wait for? My hope is in you. ⁸Deliver me from all my transgressions. Don't make me the reproach of the foolish. ⁹I was mute. I didn't open my mouth, because you did it. ¹⁰Remove your scourge away from me. I am overcome by the blow of your hand. ¹¹When you rebuke and correct man for iniquity, you consume his wealth like a moth. Surely every man is but a breath." ¹²"Hear my prayer, LORD, and give ear to my cry. Don't be silent at my tears. For I am a stranger with you, a foreigner, as all my fathers were. ¹³Oh spare me, that I may recover strength, before I go away and exist no more."

40I waited patiently for the LORD. He turned to me, and heard my cry. ²He brought me up also out of a horrible pit, out of the miry clay. He set my feet on a rock, and gave me a firm place to stand. ³He has put a new song in my mouth, even praise to our God. Many shall see it, and fear, and shall trust in the LORD. ⁴Blessed is the man who makes the LORD his trust, and doesn't respect the proud, nor such as turn away to lies. ⁵Many, LORD, my God, are the wonderful works which you have done, and your thoughts which are toward us. They can't be declared back to you. If I would declare and speak of them, they are more than can be counted. ⁶Sacrifice and offering you didn't desire. You have opened my ears. You have not required burnt offering and sin offering. ⁷Then I said, "Behold, I have come. It is written about me in the book in the scroll. ⁸I delight to do your will, my God. Yes, your Torah is within my heart." ⁹I have proclaimed glad news of righteousness in the great assembly. Behold, I will not seal my lips, LORD, you know. ¹⁰I have not hidden your righteousness within my heart. I have declared your faithfulness and your salvation. I have not concealed your loving kindness and your truth from the great assembly. ¹¹Don't withhold your tender mercies from me, LORD. Let your loving kindness and your truth continually preserve me. ¹²For innumerable evils have surrounded me. My iniquities have overtaken me, so that I am not able to look up. They are more than the hairs of my head. My heart has failed me. ¹³Be pleased, LORD, to deliver me. Hurry to help me, LORD. ¹⁴Let them be disappointed and confounded together who seek after my soul to destroy it. Let them be turned backward and brought to dishonor who delight in my hurt. ¹⁵Let them be desolate by reason of their shame that tell me, "Aha! Aha!" ¹⁶Let all those who seek you rejoice and be glad in you. Let such as love your salvation say continually, "Let the LORD be exalted!" ¹⁷But I am poor and needy. May the Lord think about me. You are my help and my deliverer. Don't delay, my God.

41Blessed is he who considers the poor. The LORD will deliver him in the day of evil. ²The LORD will preserve him, and keep him alive. He shall be blessed on the earth, and he will not surrender him to the will of his enemies. ³The LORD will sustain him on his sickbed, and restore him from his bed of illness. ⁴I said, "LORD, have mercy on me! Heal me, for I have sinned against you." ⁵My enemies speak evil against me: "When will he die, and his name perish?" ⁶If he comes to see me, he speaks falsehood. His heart gathers iniquity to itself. When he goes abroad, he tells it. ⁷All who hate me whisper together against me. They imagine the worst for me. ⁸"An evil disease", they say, "has afflicted him. Now that he lies he shall rise up no more." ⁹Yes, my own familiar friend, in whom I trusted, who ate bread with me, has lifted up his heel against me. ¹⁰But you, LORD, have mercy on me, and

raise me up, that I may repay them. ¹¹By this I know that you delight in me, because my enemy doesn't triumph over me. ¹²As for me, you uphold me in my integrity, and set me in your presence forever. ¹³Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting and to everlasting! Amen and amen.

42As the deer pants for the water brooks, so my soul pants after you, God. ^{xvii} ²My soul thirsts for God, for the living God. When shall I come and appear before God? ³My tears have been my food day and night, while they continually ask me, "Where is your God?" ⁴These things I remember, and pour out my soul within me, how I used to go with the crowd, and led them to God's house, with the voice of joy and praise, a multitude keeping a holy day. ⁵Why are you in despair, my soul? Why are you disturbed within me? Hope in God! For I shall still praise him for the saving help of his presence. ⁶My God, my soul is in despair within me. Therefore I remember you from the land of the Jordan, the heights of Hermon, from the hill Mizar. ⁷Deep calls to deep at the noise of your waterfalls. All your waves and your billows have swept over me. ⁸The LORD ^{xviii} will command his loving kindness in the daytime. In the night his song shall be with me: a prayer to the God of my life. ⁹I will ask God, my rock, "Why have you forgotten me? Why do I go mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?" ¹⁰As with a sword in my bones, my adversaries reproach me, while they continually ask me, "Where is your God?" ¹¹Why are you in despair, my soul? Why are you disturbed within me? Hope in God! For I shall still praise him, the saving help of my countenance, and my God.

43Vindicate me, God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation. Oh, deliver me from deceitful and wicked men. ²For you are the God of my strength. Why have you rejected me? Why do I go mourning because of the oppression of the enemy? ³Oh, send out your light and your truth. Let them lead me. Let them bring me to your holy hill, to your tents. ⁴Then I will go to the altar of God, to God, my exceeding joy. I will praise you on the harp, God, my God. ⁵Why are you in despair, my soul? Why are you disturbed within me? Hope in God! For I shall still praise him: my Savior, my helper, and my God.

44We have heard with our ears, God; our fathers have told us what work you did in their days, in the days of old. ²You drove out the nations with your hand, but you planted them. You afflicted the peoples, but you spread them abroad. ³For they didn't get the land in possession by their own sword, neither did their own arm save them;

^{xvii}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^{xviii}When rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

but your right hand, your arm, and the light of your face, because you were favorable to them. ⁴God, you are my King. Command victories for Jacob! ⁵Through you, we will push down our adversaries. Through your name, we will tread down those who rise up against us. ⁶For I will not trust in my bow, neither will my sword save me. ⁷But you have saved us from our adversaries, and have shamed those who hate us. ⁸In God we have made our boast all day long. We will give thanks to your name forever. ⁹But now you rejected us, and brought us to dishonor, and don't go out with our armies. ¹⁰You make us turn back from the adversary. Those who hate us take plunder for themselves. ¹¹You have made us like sheep for food, and have scattered us among the nations. ¹²You sell your people for nothing, and have gained nothing from their sale. ¹³You make us a reproach to our neighbors, a scoffing and a derision to those who are around us. ¹⁴You make us a byword among the nations, a shaking of the head among the peoples. ¹⁵All day long my dishonor is before me, and shame covers my face, ¹⁶at the taunt of one who reproaches and verbally abuses, because of the enemy and the avenger. ¹⁷All this has come on us, yet we haven't forgotten you. We haven't been false to your covenant. ¹⁸Our heart has not turned back, neither have our steps strayed from your path, ¹⁹though you have crushed us in the haunt of jackals, and covered us with the shadow of death. ²⁰If we have forgotten the name of our God, or spread out our hands to a strange god, ²¹won't God search this out? For he knows the secrets of the heart. ²²Yes, for your sake we are killed all day long. We are regarded as sheep for the slaughter. ²³Wake up! Why do you sleep, Lord? ^{xix} Arise! Don't reject us forever. ²⁴Why do you hide your face, and forget our affliction and our oppression? ²⁵For our soul is bowed down to the dust. Our body clings to the earth. ²⁶Rise up to help us. Redeem us for your loving kindness' sake.

45My heart overflows with a noble theme. I recite my verses for the king. My tongue is like the pen of a skillful writer. ²You are the most excellent of the sons of men. Grace has anointed your lips, therefore God has blessed you forever. ³Strap your sword on your thigh, O mighty one, in your splendor and your majesty. ⁴In your majesty ride on victoriously on behalf of truth, humility, and righteousness. Let your right hand display awesome deeds. ⁵Your arrows are sharp. The nations fall under you, with arrows in the heart of the king's enemies. ⁶Your throne, God, is forever and ever. A scepter of equity is the scepter of your kingdom. ⁷You have loved righteousness, and hated wickedness. Therefore God, your God, has anointed you with the oil of gladness above your fellows. ⁸All your garments smell like myrrh, aloes, and cassia. Out of ivory palaces stringed instruments have made you glad. ⁹Kings' daughters are among your honorable

women. At your right hand the queen stands in gold of Ophir. ¹⁰Listen, daughter, consider, and turn your ear. Forget your own people, and also your father's house. ¹¹So the king will desire your beauty, honor him, for he is your lord. ¹²The daughter of Tyre comes with a gift. The rich among the people entreat your favor. ¹³The princess inside is all glorious. Her clothing is interwoven with gold. ¹⁴She shall be led to the king in embroidered work. The virgins, her companions who follow her, shall be brought to you. ¹⁵With gladness and rejoicing they shall be led. They shall enter into the king's palace. ¹⁶Your sons will take the place of your fathers. You shall make them princes in all the earth. ¹⁷I will make your name to be remembered in all generations. Therefore the peoples shall give you thanks forever and ever.

46God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble. ²Therefore we won't be afraid, though the earth changes, though the mountains are shaken into the heart of the seas; ³though its waters roar and are troubled, though the mountains tremble with their swelling. ⁴There is a river, the streams of which make the city of God glad, the holy place of the tents of the Most High. ⁵God is within her. She shall not be moved. God will help her at dawn. ⁶The nations raged. The kingdoms were moved. He lifted his voice and the earth melted. ⁷The LORD of Hosts is with us. The God of Jacob is our refuge. ⁸Come, see the LORD's works, what desolations he has made in the earth. ⁹He makes wars cease to the end of the earth. He breaks the bow, and shatters the spear. He burns the chariots in the fire. ¹⁰"Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations. I will be exalted in the earth." ¹¹The LORD of Hosts is with us. The God of Jacob is our refuge.

47Oh clap your hands, all you nations. Shout to God with the voice of triumph! ²For the LORD Most High is awesome. He is a great King over all the earth. ³He subdues nations under us, and peoples under our feet. ⁴He chooses our inheritance for us, the glory of Jacob whom he loved. ⁵God has gone up with a shout, The LORD with the sound of a shofar. ⁶Sing praises to God! Sing praises! Sing praises to our King! Sing praises! ⁷For God is the King of all the earth. Sing praises with understanding. ⁸God reigns over the nations. God sits on his holy throne. ⁹The princes of the peoples are gathered together, the people of the God of Abraham. For the shields of the earth belong to God. He is greatly exalted!

48Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised, in the city of our God, in his holy mountain. ²Beautiful in elevation, the joy of the whole earth, is Mount Zion, on the north sides, the city of the great King. ³God has shown himself in her citadels as a refuge. ⁴For, behold, the kings

^{xix}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

assembled themselves, they passed by together. ⁵They saw it, then they were amazed. They were dismayed. They hurried away. ⁶Trembling took hold of them there, pain, as of a woman in travail. ⁷With the east wind, you break the ships of Tarshish. ⁸As we have heard, so we have seen, in the city of the LORD of Hosts, in the city of our God. God will establish it forever. ⁹We have thought about your loving kindness, God, in the middle of your temple. ¹⁰As is your name, God, so is your praise to the ends of the earth. Your right hand is full of righteousness. ¹¹Let Mount Zion be glad! Let the daughters of Judah rejoice because of your judgments. ¹²Walk about Zion, and go around her. Number its towers. ¹³Notice her bulwarks. Consider her palaces, that you may tell it to the next generation. ¹⁴For this God is our God forever and ever. He will be our guide even to death.

49Hear this, all you peoples. Listen, all you inhabitants of the world, ²both low and high, rich and poor together. ³My mouth will speak words of wisdom. My heart will utter understanding. ⁴I will incline my ear to a proverb. I will solve my riddle on the harp. ⁵Why should I fear in the days of evil, when iniquity at my heels surrounds me? ⁶Those who trust in their wealth, and boast in the multitude of their riches— ⁷none of them can by any means redeem his brother, nor give God a ransom for him. ⁸For the redemption of their life is costly, no payment is ever enough, ⁹that he should live on forever, that he should not see corruption. ¹⁰For he sees that wise men die; likewise the fool and the senseless perish, and leave their wealth to others. ¹¹Their inward thought is that their houses will endure forever, and their dwelling places to all generations. They name their lands after themselves. ¹²But man, despite his riches, doesn't endure. He is like the animals that perish. ¹³This is the destiny of those who are foolish, and of those who approve their sayings. ¹⁴They are appointed as a flock for Sheol. ^{xx} Death shall be their shepherd. The upright shall have dominion over them in the morning. Their beauty shall decay in Sheol, ^{xxi} far from their mansion. ¹⁵But God will redeem my soul from the power of Sheol, ^{xxii} for he will receive me. ¹⁶Don't be afraid when a man is made rich, when the glory of his house is increased; ¹⁷for when he dies he will carry nothing away. His glory won't descend after him. ¹⁸Though while he lived he blessed his soul— and men praise you when you do well for yourself— ¹⁹he shall go to the generation of his fathers. They shall never see the light. ²⁰A man who has riches without understanding, is like the animals that perish.

50The Mighty One, God, The LORD, speaks, and calls

^{xx}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xxi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xxii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

the earth from sunrise to sunset. ²Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God shines out. ³Our God comes, and does not keep silent. A fire devours before him. It is very stormy around him. ⁴He calls to the heavens above, to the earth, that he may judge his people: ⁵"Gather my holy ones together to me, those who have made a covenant with me by sacrifice." ⁶The heavens shall declare his righteousness, for God himself is judge. Selah. ⁷"Hear, my people, and I will speak. Israel, I will testify against you. I am God, your God. ⁸I don't rebuke you for your sacrifices. Your burnt offerings are continually before me. ⁹I have no need for a bull from your stall, nor male goats from your pens. ¹⁰For every animal of the forest is mine, and the livestock on a thousand hills. ¹¹I know all the birds of the mountains. The wild animals of the field are mine. ¹²If I were hungry, I would not tell you, for the world is mine, and all that is in it. ¹³Will I eat the meat of bulls, or drink the blood of goats? ¹⁴Offer to God the sacrifice of thanksgiving. Pay your vows to the Most High. ¹⁵Call on me in the day of trouble. I will deliver you, and you will honor me." ¹⁶But to the wicked God says, "What right do you have to declare my statutes, that you have taken my covenant on your lips, ¹⁷since you hate instruction, and throw my words behind you? ¹⁸When you saw a thief, you consented with him, and have participated with adulterers. ¹⁹"You give your mouth to evil. Your tongue frames deceit. ²⁰You sit and speak against your brother. You slander your own mother's son. ²¹You have done these things, and I kept silent. You thought that I was just like you. I will rebuke you, and accuse you in front of your eyes. ²²"Now consider this, you who forget God, lest I tear you into pieces, and there be no one to deliver. ²³Whoever offers the sacrifice of thanksgiving glorifies me, and prepares his way so that I will show God's salvation to him."

51Have mercy on me, God, according to your loving kindness. According to the multitude of your tender mercies, blot out my transgressions. ²Wash me thoroughly from my iniquity. Cleanse me from my sin. ³For I know my transgressions. My sin is constantly before me. ⁴Against you, and you only, I have sinned, and done that which is evil in your sight, so you may be proved right when you speak, and justified when you judge. ⁵Behold, I was born in iniquity. My mother conceived me in sin. ⁶Behold, you desire truth in the inward parts. You teach me wisdom in the inmost place. ⁷Purify me with hyssop, and I will be clean. Wash me, and I will be whiter than snow. ⁸Let me hear joy and gladness, that the bones which you have broken may rejoice. ⁹Hide your face from my sins, and blot out all of my iniquities. ¹⁰Create in me a clean heart, O God. Renew a right spirit within me. ¹¹Don't throw me from your presence, and don't take your Holy Spirit from me. ¹²Restore to me the joy of your salvation. Uphold me with a willing spirit. ¹³Then I will teach transgressors your

ways. Sinners will be converted to you. ¹⁴Deliver me from the guilt of bloodshed, O God, the God of my salvation. My tongue will sing aloud of your righteousness. ¹⁵Lord, open my lips. My mouth will declare your praise. ¹⁶For you don't delight in sacrifice, or else I would give it. You have no pleasure in burnt offering. ¹⁷The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit. O God, you will not despise a broken and contrite heart. ¹⁸Do well in your good pleasure to Zion. Build the walls of Jerusalem. ¹⁹Then you will delight in the sacrifices of righteousness, in burnt offerings and in whole burnt offerings. Then they will offer bulls on your altar.

52Why do you boast of mischief, mighty man? God's loving kindness endures continually. ²Your tongue plots destruction, like a sharp razor, working deceitfully. ³You love evil more than good, lying rather than speaking the truth. ⁴You love all devouring words, you deceitful tongue. ⁵God will likewise destroy you forever. He will take you up, and pluck you out of your tent, and root you out of the land of the living. Selah. ⁶The righteous also will see it, and fear, and laugh at him, saying, ⁷"Behold, this is the man who didn't make God his strength, but trusted in the abundance of his riches, and strengthened himself in his wickedness." ⁸But as for me, I am like a green olive tree in God's house. I trust in God's loving kindness forever and ever. ⁹I will give you thanks forever, because you have done it. I will hope in your name, for it is good, in the presence of your holy ones.

53The fool has said in his heart, "There is no God." They are corrupt, and have done abominable iniquity. There is no one who does good. ²God looks down from heaven on the children of men, to see if there are any who understood, who seek after God. ³Every one of them has gone back. They have become filthy together. There is no one who does good, no, not one. ⁴Have the workers of iniquity no knowledge, who eat up my people as they eat bread, and don't call on God? ⁵There they were in great fear, where no fear was, for God has scattered the bones of him who encamps against you. You have put them to shame, because God has rejected them. ⁶Oh that the salvation [yeshuat] of Israel would come out of Zion! When God brings back his people from captivity, then Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel shall be glad.

54Save me, God, by your name. Vindicate me in your might. ²Hear my prayer, God. Listen to the words of my mouth. ³For strangers have risen up against me. Violent men have sought after my soul. They haven't set God before them. ⁴Behold, God is my helper. The Lord is the one who sustains my soul. ⁵He will repay the evil to my enemies. Destroy them in your truth. ⁶With a free will offering, I will sacrifice to you. I will give thanks to your

name, LORD, for it is good. ⁷For he has delivered me out of all trouble. My eye has seen triumph over my enemies.

55Listen to my prayer, God. Don't hide yourself from my supplication. ²Attend to me, and answer me. I am restless in my complaint, and moan ³because of the voice of the enemy, because of the oppression of the wicked. For they bring suffering on me. In anger they hold a grudge against me. ⁴My heart is severely pained within me. The terrors of death have fallen on me. ⁵Fearfulness and trembling have come on me. Horror has overwhelmed me. ⁶I said, "Oh that I had wings like a dove! Then I would fly away, and be at rest. ⁷Behold, then I would wander far off. I would lodge in the wilderness." ⁸"I would hurry to a shelter from the stormy wind and storm." ⁹Confuse them, Lord, and confound their language, for I have seen violence and strife in the city. ¹⁰Day and night they prowl around on its walls. Malice and abuse are also within her. ¹¹Destructive forces are within her. Threats and lies don't depart from her streets. ¹²For it was not an enemy who insulted me, then I could have endured it. Neither was it he who hated me who raised himself up against me, then I would have hidden myself from him. ¹³But it was you, a man like me, my companion, and my familiar friend. ¹⁴We took sweet fellowship together. We walked in God's house with company. ¹⁵Let death come suddenly on them. Let them go down alive into Sheol. ^{xxiii} For wickedness is among them, in their dwelling. ¹⁶As for me, I will call on God. The LORD will save me. ¹⁷Evening, morning, and at noon, I will cry out in distress. He will hear my voice. ¹⁸He has redeemed my soul in peace from the battle that was against me, although there are many who oppose me. ¹⁹God, who is enthroned forever, will hear and answer them. They never change and don't fear God. ²⁰He raises his hands against his friends. He has violated his covenant. ²¹His mouth was smooth as butter, but his heart was war. His words were softer than oil, yet they were drawn swords. ²²Cast your burden on the LORD and he will sustain you. He will never allow the righteous to be moved. ²³But you, God, will bring them down into the pit of destruction. Bloodthirsty and deceitful men shall not live out half their days, but I will trust in you.

56Be merciful to me, God, for man wants to swallow me up. All day long, he attacks and oppresses me. ²My enemies want to swallow me up all day long, for they are many who fight proudly against me. ³When I am afraid, I will put my trust in you. ⁴In God, I praise his word. In God, I put my trust. I will not be afraid. What can flesh do to me? ⁵All day long they twist my words. All their thoughts are against me for evil. ⁶They conspire and lurk, watching my steps. They are eager to take my life. ⁷Shall they escape by iniquity? In anger cast down the peoples,

^{xxiii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

God. ⁸You count my wanderings. You put my tears into your container. Aren't they in your book? ⁹Then my enemies shall turn back in the day that I call. I know this: that God is for me. ¹⁰In God, I will praise his word. In the LORD, I will praise his word. ¹¹I have put my trust in God. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me? ¹²Your vows are on me, God. I will give thank offerings to you. ¹³For you have delivered my soul from death, and prevented my feet from falling, that I may walk before God in the light of the living.

57 Be merciful to me, God, be merciful to me, for my soul takes refuge in you. Yes, in the shadow of your wings, I will take refuge, until disaster has passed. ²I cry out to God Most High, to God who accomplishes my requests for me. ³He will send from heaven, and save me, he rebukes the one who is pursuing me. God will send out his loving kindness and his truth. ⁴My soul is among lions. I lie among those who are set on fire, even the sons of men, whose teeth are spears and arrows, and their tongue a sharp sword. ⁵Be exalted, God, above the heavens! Let your glory be above all the earth! ⁶They have prepared a net for my steps. My soul is bowed down. They dig a pit before me. They fall into the middle of it themselves. ⁷My heart is steadfast, God. My heart is steadfast. I will sing, yes, I will sing praises. ⁸Wake up, my glory! Wake up, lute and harp! I will wake up the dawn. ⁹I will give thanks to you, Lord, among the peoples. I will sing praises to you among the nations. ¹⁰For your great loving kindness reaches to the heavens, and your truth to the skies. ¹¹Be exalted, God, above the heavens. Let your glory be over all the earth.

58 Do you indeed speak righteousness, silent ones? Do you judge blamelessly, you sons of men? ²No, in your heart you plot injustice. You measure out the violence of your hands in the earth. ³The wicked go astray from the womb. They are wayward as soon as they are born, speaking lies. ⁴Their poison is like the poison of a snake, like a deaf cobra that stops its ear, ⁵which doesn't listen to the voice of charmers, no matter how skillful the charmer may be. ⁶Break their teeth, God, in their mouth. Break out the great teeth of the young lions, LORD. ⁷Let them vanish like water that flows away. When they draw the bow, let their arrows be made blunt. ⁸Let them be like a snail which melts and passes away, like the stillborn child, who has not seen the sun. ⁹Before your pots can feel the heat of the thorns, he will sweep away the green and the burning alike. ¹⁰The righteous shall rejoice when he sees the vengeance. He shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked, ¹¹so that men shall say, "Most certainly there is a reward for the righteous. Most certainly there is a God who judges the earth."

59 Deliver me from my enemies, my God. Set me on high from those who rise up against me. ²Deliver me from the workers of iniquity. Save me from the bloodthirsty men. ³For, behold, they lie in wait for my soul. The mighty gather themselves together against me, not for my disobedience, nor for my sin, LORD. ⁴I have done no wrong, yet they are ready to attack me. Rise up, behold, and help me! ⁵You, LORD God of Hosts, the God of Israel, rouse yourself to punish the nations. Show no mercy to the wicked traitors. ⁶They return at evening, howling like dogs, and prowl around the city. ⁷Behold, they spew with their mouth. Swords are in their lips, "For", they say, "who hears us?" ⁸But you, LORD, laugh at them. You scoff at all the nations. ⁹Oh, my Strength, I watch for you, for God is my high tower. ¹⁰My God will go before me with his loving kindness. God will let me look at my enemies in triumph. ¹¹Don't kill them, or my people may forget. Scatter them by your power, and bring them down, Lord our shield. ¹²For the sin of their mouth, and the words of their lips, let them be caught in their pride, for the curses and lies which they utter. ¹³Consume them in wrath. Consume them, and they will be no more. Let them know that God rules in Jacob, to the ends of the earth. ¹⁴At evening let them return. Let them howl like a dog, and go around the city. ¹⁵They shall wander up and down for food, and wait all night if they aren't satisfied. ¹⁶But I will sing of your strength. Yes, I will sing aloud of your loving kindness in the morning. For you have been my high tower, a refuge in the day of my distress. ¹⁷To you, my strength, I will sing praises. For God is my high tower, the God of my mercy.

60 God, you have rejected us. You have broken us down. You have been angry. Restore us, again. ²You have made the land tremble. You have torn it. Mend its fractures, for it quakes. ³You have shown your people hard things. You have made us drink the wine that makes us stagger. ⁴You have given a banner to those who fear you, that it may be displayed because of the truth. ⁵So that your beloved may be delivered, save with your right hand, and answer us. ⁶God has spoken from his sanctuary: "I will triumph. I will divide Shechem, and measure out the valley of Succoth. ⁷Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine. Ephraim also is the defense of my head. Judah is my scepter. ⁸Moab is my wash basin. I will throw my sandal on Edom. I shout in triumph over Philistia." ⁹Who will bring me into the strong city? Who has led me to Edom? ¹⁰Haven't you, God, rejected us? You don't go out with our armies, God. ¹¹Give us help against the adversary, for the help of man is vain. ¹²Through God we will do valiantly, for it is he who will tread down our adversaries.

61 Hear my cry, God. Listen to my prayer. ²From the end of the earth, I will call to you when my heart is

overwhelmed. Lead me to the rock that is higher than I. ³For you have been a refuge for me, a strong tower from the enemy. ⁴I will dwell in your tent forever. I will take refuge in the shelter of your wings. ⁵For you, God, have heard my vows. You have given me the heritage of those who fear your name. ⁶You will prolong the king's life. His years will be for generations. ⁷He shall be enthroned in God's presence forever. Appoint your loving kindness and truth, that they may preserve him. ⁸So I will sing praise to your name forever, that I may fulfill my vows daily.

62My soul rests in God alone. My salvation [yeshuah-ti] is from him. ²He alone is my rock, my salvation, and my fortress. I will never be greatly shaken. ³How long will you assault a man? Would all of you throw him down, like a leaning wall, like a tottering fence? ⁴They fully intend to throw him down from his lofty place. They delight in lies. They bless with their mouth, but they curse inwardly. ⁵My soul, wait in silence for God alone, for my expectation is from him. ⁶He alone is my rock and my salvation [yeshuah-ti], my fortress. I will not be shaken. ⁷My salvation and my honor is with God. The rock of my strength, and my refuge, is in God. ⁸Trust in him at all times, you people. Pour out your heart before him. God is a refuge for us. ⁹Surely men of low degree are just a breath, and men of high degree are a lie. In the balances they will go up. They are together lighter than a breath. ¹⁰Don't trust in oppression. Don't become vain in robbery. If riches increase, don't set your heart on them. ¹¹God has spoken once; twice I have heard this, that power belongs to God. ¹²Also to you, Lord, belongs loving kindness, for you reward every man according to his work.

63God, you are my God. I will earnestly seek you. My soul thirsts for you. My flesh longs for you, in a dry and weary land, where there is no water. ²So I have seen you in the sanctuary, watching your power and your glory. ³Because your loving kindness is better than life, my lips shall praise you. ⁴So I will bless you while I live. I will lift up my hands in your name. ⁵My soul shall be satisfied as with the richest food. My mouth shall praise you with joyful lips, ⁶when I remember you on my bed, and think about you in the night watches. ⁷For you have been my help. I will rejoice in the shadow of your wings. ⁸My soul stays close to you. Your right hand holds me up. ⁹But those who seek my soul to destroy it shall go into the lower parts of the earth. ¹⁰They shall be given over to the power of the sword. They shall be jackal food. ¹¹But the king shall rejoice in God. Everyone who swears by him will praise him, for the mouth of those who speak lies shall be silenced.

64Hear my voice, God, in my complaint. Preserve my life from fear of the enemy. ²Hide me from the con-

spiracy of the wicked, from the noisy crowd of the ones doing evil; ³who sharpen their tongue like a sword, and aim their arrows, deadly words, ⁴to shoot innocent men from ambushes. They shoot at him suddenly and fearlessly. ⁵They encourage themselves in evil plans. They talk about laying snares secretly. They say, "Who will see them?" ⁶They plot injustice, saying, "We have made a perfect plan!" Surely man's mind and heart are cunning. ⁷But God will shoot at them. They will be suddenly struck down with an arrow. ⁸Their own tongues shall ruin them. All who see them will shake their heads. ⁹All mankind shall be afraid. They shall declare the work of God, and shall wisely ponder what he has done. ¹⁰The righteous shall be glad in the LORD, and shall take refuge in him. All the upright in heart shall praise him!

65Praise waits for you, God, in Zion. Vows shall be performed to you. ²You who hear prayer, all men will come to you. ³Sins overwhelmed me, but you atoned for our transgressions. ⁴Blessed is the one whom you choose and cause to come near, that he may live in your courts. We will be filled with the goodness of your house, your holy temple. ⁵By awesome deeds of righteousness, you answer us, God of our salvation. You who are the hope of all the ends of the earth, of those who are far away on the sea. ⁶By your power, you form the mountains, having armed yourself with strength. ⁷You still the roaring of the seas, the roaring of their waves, and the turmoil of the nations. ⁸They also who dwell in faraway places are afraid at your wonders. You call the morning's dawn and the evening with songs of joy. ⁹You visit the earth, and water it. You greatly enrich it. The river of God is full of water. You provide them grain, for so you have ordained it. ¹⁰You drench its furrows. You level its ridges. You soften it with showers. You bless it with a crop. ¹¹You crown the year with your bounty. Your carts overflow with abundance. ¹²The wilderness grasslands overflow. The hills are clothed with gladness. ¹³The pastures are covered with flocks. The valleys also are clothed with grain. They shout for joy! They also sing.

66Make a joyful shout to God, all the earth! ²Sing to the glory of his name! Offer glory and praise! ³Tell God, "How awesome are your deeds! Through the greatness of your power, your enemies submit themselves to you. ⁴All the earth will worship you, and will sing to you; they will sing to your name." Selah. ⁵Come, and see God's deeds—awesome work on behalf of the children of men. ⁶He turned the sea into dry land. They went through the river on foot. There, we rejoiced in him. ⁷He rules by his might forever. His eyes watch the nations. Don't let the rebellious rise up against him. Selah. ⁸Praise our God, you peoples! Make the sound of his praise heard, ⁹who preserves our life among the living, and doesn't allow our feet to be moved.

¹⁰For you, God, have tested us. You have refined us, as silver is refined. ¹¹You brought us into prison. You laid a burden on our backs. ¹²You allowed men to ride over our heads. We went through fire and through water, but you brought us to the place of abundance. ¹³I will come into your temple with burnt offerings. I will pay my vows to you, ¹⁴which my lips promised, and my mouth spoke, when I was in distress. ¹⁵I will offer to you burnt offerings of fat animals, with the offering of rams, I will offer bulls with goats. Selah. ¹⁶Come and hear, all you who fear God. I will declare what he has done for my soul. ¹⁷I cried to him with my mouth. He was extolled with my tongue. ¹⁸If I cherished sin in my heart, the Lord wouldn't have listened. ¹⁹But most certainly, God has listened. He has heard the voice of my prayer. ²⁰Blessed be God, who has not turned away my prayer, nor his loving kindness from me.

67 May God be merciful to us, bless us, and cause his face to shine on us. ²That your way may be known on earth, and your salvation [yeshuat] among all nations, ³let the peoples praise you, God. Let all the peoples praise you. ⁴Oh let the nations be glad and sing for joy, for you will judge the peoples with equity, and govern the nations on earth. ⁵Let the peoples praise you, God. Let all the peoples praise you. ⁶The earth has yielded its increase. God, even our own God, will bless us. ⁷God will bless us. All the ends of the earth shall fear him.

68 Let God arise! Let his enemies be scattered! Let them who hate him also flee before him. ²As smoke is driven away, so drive them away. As wax melts before the fire, so let the wicked perish at the presence of God. ³But let the righteous be glad. Let them rejoice before God. Yes, let them rejoice with gladness. ⁴Sing to God! Sing praises to his name! Extol him who rides on the clouds: to the LORD, his name! Rejoice before him! ⁵A father of the fatherless, and a defender of the widows, is God in his holy habitation. ⁶God sets the lonely in families. He brings out the prisoners with singing, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land. ⁷God, when you went out before your people, when you marched through the wilderness... ⁸The earth trembled. The sky also poured down rain at the presence of the God of Sinai— at the presence of God, the God of Israel. ⁹You, God, sent a plentiful rain. You confirmed your inheritance when it was weary. ¹⁰Your congregation lived therein. You, God, prepared your goodness for the poor. ¹¹The Lord announced the word. The ones who proclaim it are a great company. ¹²"Kings of armies flee! They flee!" She who waits at home divides the plunder, ¹³while you sleep among the camp fires, the wings of a dove sheathed with silver, her feathers with shining gold. ¹⁴When the Almighty scattered kings in her, it snowed on Zalmon. ¹⁵The mountains of Bashan are majestic mountains. The mountains of Bashan are rugged.

¹⁶Why do you look in envy, you rugged mountains, at the mountain where God chooses to reign? Yes, the LORD will dwell there forever. ¹⁷The chariots of God are tens of thousands and thousands of thousands. The Lord is among them, from Sinai, into the sanctuary. ¹⁸You have ascended on high. You have led away captives. You have received gifts among people, yes, among the rebellious also, that the LORD God might dwell there. ¹⁹Blessed be the Lord, who daily bears our burdens, even the God who is our salvation. ²⁰God is to us a God of deliverance. To the LORD, the Lord, belongs escape from death. ²¹But God will strike through the head of his enemies, the hairy scalp of such a one as still continues in his guiltiness. ²²The Lord said, "I will bring you again from Bashan, I will bring you again from the depths of the sea, ²³that you may crush them, dipping your foot in blood, that the tongues of your dogs may have their portion from your enemies." ²⁴They have seen your processions, God, even the processions of my God, my King, into the sanctuary. ²⁵The singers went before, the minstrels followed after, among the ladies playing with tambourines, ²⁶"Bless God in the congregations, even the Lord in the assembly of Israel!" ²⁷There is little Benjamin, their ruler, the princes of Judah, their council, the princes of Zebulun, and the princes of Naphtali. ²⁸Your God has commanded your strength. Strengthen, God, that which you have done for us. ²⁹Because of your temple at Jerusalem, kings shall bring presents to you. ³⁰Rebuke the wild animal of the reeds, the multitude of the bulls with the calves of the peoples. Trample under foot the bars of silver. Scatter the nations who delight in war. ³¹Princes shall come out of Egypt. Ethiopia shall hurry to stretch out her hands to God. ³²Sing to God, you kingdoms of the earth! Sing praises to the Lord— ³³to him who rides on the heaven of heavens, which are of old; behold, he utters his voice, a mighty voice. ³⁴Ascribe strength to God! His excellency is over Israel, his strength is in the skies. ³⁵You are awesome, God, in your sanctuaries. The God of Israel gives strength and power to his people. Praise be to God!

69 Save me, God, for the waters have come up to my neck! ²I sink in deep mire, where there is no foothold. I have come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me. ³I am weary with my crying. My throat is dry. My eyes fail looking for my God. ⁴Those who hate me without a cause are more than the hairs of my head. Those who want to cut me off, being my enemies wrongfully, are mighty. I have to restore what I didn't take away. ⁵God, you know my foolishness. My sins aren't hidden from you. ⁶Don't let those who wait for you be shamed through me, Lord GOD of Hosts. Don't let those who seek you be brought to dishonor through me, God of Israel. ⁷Because for your sake, I have borne reproach. Shame has covered my face. ⁸I have become a stranger to my brothers, an alien to my mother's children. ⁹For the zeal of your house consumes

me. The reproaches of those who reproach you have fallen on me. ¹⁰When I wept and I fasted, that was to my reproach. ¹¹When I made sackcloth my clothing, I became a byword to them. ¹²Those who sit in the gate talk about me. I am the song of the drunkards. ¹³But as for me, my prayer is to you, LORD, in an acceptable time. God, in the abundance of your loving kindness, answer me in the truth of your salvation. ¹⁴Deliver me out of the mire, and don't let me sink. Let me be delivered from those who hate me, and out of the deep waters. ¹⁵Don't let the flood waters overwhelm me, neither let the deep swallow me up. Don't let the pit shut its mouth on me. ¹⁶Answer me, LORD, for your loving kindness is good. According to the multitude of your tender mercies, turn to me. ¹⁷Don't hide your face from your servant, for I am in distress. Answer me speedily! ¹⁸Draw near to my soul and redeem it. Ransom me because of my enemies. ¹⁹You know my reproach, my shame, and my dishonor. My adversaries are all before you. ²⁰Reproach has broken my heart, and I am full of heaviness. I looked for some to take pity, but there was none; for comforters, but I found none. ²¹They also gave me poison for my food. In my thirst, they gave me vinegar to drink. ²²Let their table before them become a snare. May it become a retribution and a trap. ²³Let their eyes be darkened, so that they can't see. Let their backs be continually bent. ²⁴Pour out your indignation on them. Let the fierceness of your anger overtake them. ²⁵Let their habitation be desolate. Let no one dwell in their tents. ²⁶For they persecute him whom you have wounded. They tell of the sorrow of those whom you have hurt. ²⁷Charge them with crime upon crime. Don't let them come into your righteousness. ²⁸Let them be blotted out of the book of life, and not be written with the righteous. ²⁹But I am in pain and distress. Let your salvation, God, protect me. ³⁰I will praise the name of God with a song, and will magnify him with thanksgiving. ³¹It will please the LORD better than an ox, or a bull that has horns and hoofs. ³²The humble have seen it, and are glad. You who seek after God, let your heart live. ³³For the LORD hears the needy, and doesn't despise his captive people. ³⁴Let heaven and earth praise him; the seas, and everything that moves therein! ³⁵For God will save Zion, and build the cities of Judah. They shall settle there, and own it. ³⁶The children also of his servants shall inherit it. Those who love his name shall dwell therein.

70 Hurry, God, to deliver me. Come quickly to help me, LORD. ²Let them be disappointed and confounded who seek my soul. Let those who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace. ³Let them be turned because of their shame who say, "Aha! Aha!" ⁴Let all those who seek you rejoice and be glad in you. Let those who love your salvation continually say, "Let God be exalted!" ⁵But I am poor and needy. Come to me quickly, God. You are

my help and my deliverer. LORD, don't delay.

71 In you, LORD, I take refuge. Never let me be disappointed. ²Deliver me in your righteousness, and rescue me. Turn your ear to me, and save me. ³Be to me a rock of refuge to which I may always go. Give the command to save me, for you are my rock and my fortress. ⁴Rescue me, my God, from the hand of the wicked, from the hand of the unrighteous and cruel man. ⁵For you are my hope, Lord GOD, my confidence from my youth. ⁶I have relied on you from the womb. You are he who took me out of my mother's womb. I will always praise you. ⁷I am a marvel to many, but you are my strong refuge. ⁸My mouth shall be filled with your praise, with your honor all day long. ⁹Don't reject me in my old age. Don't forsake me when my strength fails. ¹⁰For my enemies talk about me. Those who watch for my soul conspire together, ¹¹saying, "God has forsaken him. Pursue and take him, for no one will rescue him." ¹²God, don't be far from me. My God, hurry to help me. ¹³Let my accusers be disappointed and consumed. Let them be covered with disgrace and scorn who want to harm me. ¹⁴But I will always hope, and will add to all of your praise. ¹⁵My mouth will tell about your righteousness, and of your salvation all day, though I don't know its full measure. ¹⁶I will come with the mighty acts of the Lord GOD. I will make mention of your righteousness, even of yours alone. ¹⁷God, you have taught me from my youth. Until now, I have declared your wondrous works. ¹⁸Yes, even when I am old and gray-haired, God, don't forsake me, until I have declared your strength to the next generation, your might to everyone who is to come. ¹⁹God, your righteousness also reaches to the heavens. You have done great things. God, who is like you? ²⁰You, who have shown us many and bitter troubles, you will let me live. You will bring us up again from the depths of the earth. ²¹Increase my honor and comfort me again. ²²I will also praise you with the harp for your faithfulness, my God. I sing praises to you with the lyre, Holy One of Israel. ²³My lips shall shout for joy! My soul, which you have redeemed, sings praises to you! ²⁴My tongue will also talk about your righteousness all day long, for they are disappointed, and they are confounded, who want to harm me.

72 God, give the king your justice; your righteousness to the royal son. ²He will judge your people with righteousness, and your poor with justice. ³The mountains shall bring prosperity to the people. The hills bring the fruit of righteousness. ⁴He will judge the poor of the people. He will save the children of the needy, and will break the oppressor in pieces. ⁵They shall fear you while the sun endures; and as long as the moon, throughout all generations. ⁶He will come down like rain on the mown grass, as showers that water the earth. ⁷In his days, the righteous shall flourish, and abundance of peace, until the moon is

no more. ⁸He shall have dominion also from sea to sea, from the River to the ends of the earth. ⁹Those who dwell in the wilderness shall bow before him. His enemies shall lick the dust. ¹⁰The kings of Tarshish and of the islands will bring tribute. The kings of Sheba and Seba shall offer gifts. ¹¹Yes, all kings shall fall down before him. All nations shall serve him. ¹²For he will deliver the needy when he cries; the poor, who has no helper. ¹³He will have pity on the poor and needy. He will save the souls of the needy. ¹⁴He will redeem their soul from oppression and violence. Their blood will be precious in his sight. ¹⁵He will live; and Sheba's gold will be given to him. Men will pray for him continually. They will bless him all day long. ¹⁶Abundance of grain shall be throughout the land. Its fruit sways like Lebanon. Let it flourish, thriving like the grass of the field. ¹⁷His name endures forever. His name continues as long as the sun. Men shall be blessed by him. All nations will call him blessed. ¹⁸Praise be to the LORD God, the God of Israel, who alone does marvelous deeds. ¹⁹Blessed be his glorious name forever! Let the whole earth be filled with his glory! Amen and amen. ²⁰This ends the prayers by David, the son of Jesse.

73 Surely God ^{xxiv} is good to Israel, to those who are pure in heart. ²But as for me, my feet were almost gone. My steps had nearly slipped. ³For I was envious of the arrogant, when I saw the prosperity of the wicked. ⁴For there are no struggles in their death, but their strength is firm. ⁵They are free from burdens of men, neither are they plagued like other men. ⁶Therefore pride is like a chain around their neck. Violence covers them like a garment. ⁷Their eyes bulge with fat. Their minds pass the limits of conceit. ⁸They scoff and speak with malice. In arrogance, they threaten oppression. ⁹They have set their mouth in the heavens. Their tongue walks through the earth. ¹⁰Therefore their people return to them, and they drink up waters of abundance. ¹¹They say, "How does God know? Is there knowledge in the Most High?" ¹²Behold, these are the wicked. Being always at ease, they increase in riches. ¹³Surely I have cleansed my heart in vain, and washed my hands in innocence, ¹⁴For all day long I have been plagued, and punished every morning. ¹⁵If I had said, "I will speak thus", behold, I would have betrayed the generation of your children. ¹⁶When I tried to understand this, it was too painful for me— ¹⁷until I entered God's sanctuary, and considered their latter end. ¹⁸Surely you set them in slippery places. You throw them down to destruction. ¹⁹How they are suddenly destroyed! They are completely swept away with terrors. ²⁰As a dream when one wakes up, so, Lord, ^{xxv} when you awake, you will despise their fantasies. ²¹For my soul was grieved. I was embittered in my heart. ²²I was so senseless and ignorant.

I was a brute beast before you. ²³Nevertheless, I am continually with you. You have held my right hand. ²⁴You will guide me with your counsel, and afterward receive me to glory. ²⁵Whom do I have in heaven? There is no one on earth whom I desire besides you. ²⁶My flesh and my heart fails, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever. ²⁷For, behold, those who are far from you shall perish. You have destroyed all those who are unfaithful to you. ²⁸But it is good for me to come close to God. I have made the Lord the LORD ^{xxvi} my refuge, that I may tell of all your works.

74 God, why have you rejected us forever? Why does your anger smolder against the sheep of your pasture? ²Remember your congregation, which you purchased of old, which you have redeemed to be the tribe of your inheritance: Mount Zion, in which you have lived. ³Lift up your feet to the perpetual ruins, all the evil that the enemy has done in the sanctuary. ⁴Your adversaries have roared in the middle of your assembly. They have set up their standards as signs. ⁵They behaved like men wielding axes, cutting through a thicket of trees. ⁶Now they break all its carved work down with hatchet and hammers. ⁷They have burned your sanctuary to the ground. They have profaned the dwelling place of your Name. ⁸They said in their heart, "We will crush them completely." They have burned up all the places in the land where God was worshiped. ⁹We see no miraculous signs. There is no longer any prophet, neither is there among us anyone who knows how long. ¹⁰How long, God, shall the adversary reproach? Shall the enemy blaspheme your name forever? ¹¹Why do you draw back your hand, even your right hand? Take it from your chest and consume them! ¹²Yet God is my King of old, working salvation throughout the earth. ¹³You divided the sea by your strength. You broke the heads of the sea monsters in the waters. ¹⁴You broke the heads of Leviathan in pieces. You gave him as food to people and desert creatures. ¹⁵You opened up spring and stream. You dried up mighty rivers. ¹⁶The day is yours, the night is also yours. You have prepared the light and the sun. ¹⁷You have set all the boundaries of the earth. You have made summer and winter. ¹⁸Remember this, that the enemy has mocked you, LORD. Foolish people have blasphemed your name. ¹⁹Don't deliver the soul of your dove to wild beasts. Don't forget the life of your poor forever. ²⁰Honor your covenant, for haunts of violence fill the dark places of the earth. ²¹Don't let the oppressed return ashamed. Let the poor and needy praise your name. ²²Arise, God! Plead your own cause. Remember how the foolish man mocks you all day. ²³Don't forget the voice of your adversaries. The tumult of those who rise up against you ascends continually.

^{xxiv}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^{xxv}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{xxvi}When rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

75We give thanks to you, God. We give thanks, for your Name is near. Men tell about your wondrous works. ²When I choose the appointed time, I will judge blamelessly. ³The earth and all its inhabitants quake. I firmly hold its pillars. ⁴I said to the arrogant, "Don't boast!" I said to the wicked, "Don't lift up the horn. ⁵Don't lift up your horn on high. Don't speak with a stiff neck." ⁶For neither from the east, nor from the west, nor yet from the south, comes exaltation. ⁷But God is the judge. He puts down one, and lifts up another. ⁸For in the LORD's hand there is a cup, full of foaming wine mixed with spices. He pours it out. Indeed the wicked of the earth drink and drink it to its very dregs. ⁹But I will declare this forever: I will sing praises to the God of Jacob. ¹⁰I will cut off all the horns of the wicked, but the horns of the righteous shall be lifted up.

76In Judah, God is known. His name is great in Israel. ²His tabernacle is also in Salem. His dwelling place in Zion. ³There he broke the flaming arrows of the bow, the shield, and the sword, and the weapons of war. ⁴Glorious are you, and excellent, more than mountains of game. ⁵Valiant men lie plundered, they have slept their last sleep. None of the men of war can lift their hands. ⁶At your rebuke, God of Jacob, both chariot and horse are cast into a dead sleep. ⁷You, even you, are to be feared. Who can stand in your sight when you are angry? ⁸You pronounced judgment from heaven. The earth feared, and was silent, ⁹when God arose to judgment, to save all the afflicted ones of the earth. ¹⁰Surely the wrath of man praises you. The survivors of your wrath are restrained. ¹¹Make vows to the LORD your God, and fulfill them! Let all of his neighbors bring presents to him who is to be feared. ¹²He will cut off the spirit of princes. He is feared by the kings of the earth.

77My cry goes to God! Indeed, I cry to God for help, and for him to listen to me. ²In the day of my trouble I sought the Lord. My hand was stretched out in the night, and didn't get tired. My soul refused to be comforted. ³I remember God, and I groan. I complain, and my spirit is overwhelmed. ⁴You hold my eyelids open. I am so troubled that I can't speak. ⁵I have considered the days of old, the years of ancient times. ⁶I remember my song in the night. I consider in my own heart; my spirit diligently inquires: ⁷"Will the Lord reject us forever? Will he be favorable no more? ⁸Has his loving kindness vanished forever? Does his promise fail for generations? ⁹Has God forgotten to be gracious? Has he, in anger, withheld his compassion?" ¹⁰Then I thought, "I will appeal to this: the years of the right hand of the Most High." ¹¹I will remember the LORD's deeds; for I will remember your wonders of old. ¹²I will also meditate on all your work, and consider your doings. ¹³Your way, God, is in the sanctuary. What god is great like God? ¹⁴You are the God who does

wonders. You have made your strength known among the peoples. ¹⁵You have redeemed your people with your arm, the sons of Jacob and Joseph. ¹⁶The waters saw you, God. The waters saw you, and they writhed. The depths also convulsed. ¹⁷The clouds poured out water. The skies resounded with thunder. Your arrows also flashed around. ¹⁸The voice of your thunder was in the whirlwind. The lightnings lit up the world. The earth trembled and shook. ¹⁹Your way was through the sea, your paths through the great waters. Your footsteps were not known. ²⁰You led your people like a flock, by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

78Hear my teaching, my people. Turn your ears to the words of my mouth. ²I will open my mouth in a parable. I will utter dark sayings of old, ³which we have heard and known, and our fathers have told us. ⁴We will not hide them from their children, telling to the generation to come the praises of the LORD, his strength, and his wondrous deeds that he has done. ⁵For he established a covenant in Jacob, and appointed a teaching in Israel, which he commanded our fathers, that they should make them known to their children; ⁶that the generation to come might know, even the children who should be born; who should arise and tell their children, ⁷that they might set their hope in God, and not forget God's deeds, but keep his commandments, ⁸and might not be as their fathers— a stubborn and rebellious generation, a generation that didn't make their hearts loyal, whose spirit was not steadfast with God. ⁹The children of Ephraim, being armed and carrying bows, turned back in the day of battle. ¹⁰They didn't keep God's covenant, and refused to walk by his Torah. ¹¹They forgot his doings, his wondrous deeds that he had shown them. ¹²He did marvelous things in the sight of their fathers, in the land of Egypt, in the field of Zoan. ¹³He split the sea, and caused them to pass through. He made the waters stand as a heap. ¹⁴In the daytime he also led them with a cloud, and all night with a light of fire. ¹⁵He split rocks in the wilderness, and gave them drink abundantly as out of the depths. ¹⁶He brought streams also out of the rock, and caused waters to run down like rivers. ¹⁷Yet they still went on to sin against him, to rebel against the Most High in the desert. ¹⁸They tempted God in their heart by asking food according to their desire. ¹⁹Yes, they spoke against God. They said, "Can God prepare a table in the wilderness? ²⁰Behold, he struck the rock, so that waters gushed out, and streams overflowed. Can he give bread also? Will he provide meat for his people?" ²¹Therefore the LORD heard, and was angry. A fire was kindled against Jacob, anger also went up against Israel, ²²because they didn't believe in God, and didn't trust in his salvation [yeshuat]. ²³Yet he commanded the skies above, and opened the doors of heaven. ²⁴He rained down manna on them to eat, and gave them food from the sky. ²⁵Man ate the bread of angels. He sent them food to the

full. ²⁶He caused the east wind to blow in the sky. By his power he guided the south wind. ²⁷He also rained meat on them as the dust, winged birds as the sand of the seas. ²⁸He let them fall in the middle of their camp, around their habitations. ²⁹So they ate, and were well filled. He gave them their own desire. ³⁰They didn't turn from their cravings. Their food was yet in their mouths, ³¹when the anger of God went up against them, killed some of their strongest, and struck down the young men of Israel. ³²For all this they still sinned, and didn't believe in his wondrous works. ³³Therefore he consumed their days in vanity, and their years in terror. ³⁴When he killed them, then they inquired after him. They returned and sought God earnestly. ³⁵They remembered that God was their rock, the Most High God, their redeemer. ³⁶But they flattered him with their mouth, and lied to him with their tongue. ³⁷For their heart was not right with him, neither were they faithful in his covenant. ³⁸But he, being merciful, forgave iniquity, and didn't destroy them. Yes, many times he turned his anger away, and didn't stir up all his wrath. ³⁹He remembered that they were but flesh, a wind that passes away, and doesn't come again. ⁴⁰How often they rebelled against him in the wilderness, and grieved him in the desert! ⁴¹They turned again and tempted God, and provoked the Holy One of Israel. ⁴²They didn't remember his hand, nor the day when he redeemed them from the adversary; ⁴³how he set his signs in Egypt, his wonders in the field of Zoan, ⁴⁴he turned their rivers into blood, and their streams, so that they could not drink. ⁴⁵He sent among them swarms of flies, which devoured them; and frogs, which destroyed them. ⁴⁶He also gave their increase to the caterpillar, and their labor to the locust. ⁴⁷He destroyed their vines with hail, their sycamore fig trees with frost. ⁴⁸He also gave over their livestock to the hail, and their flocks to hot thunderbolts. ⁴⁹He threw on them the fierceness of his anger, wrath, indignation, and trouble, and a band of angels of evil. ⁵⁰He made a path for his anger. He didn't spare their soul from death, but gave their life over to the pestilence, ⁵¹and struck all the firstborn in Egypt, the chief of their strength in the tents of Ham. ⁵²But he led out his own people like sheep, and guided them in the wilderness like a flock. ⁵³He led them safely, so that they weren't afraid, but the sea overwhelmed their enemies. ⁵⁴He brought them to the border of his sanctuary, to this mountain, which his right hand had taken. ⁵⁵He also drove out the nations before them, allotted them for an inheritance by line, and made the tribes of Israel to dwell in their tents. ⁵⁶Yet they tempted and rebelled against the Most High God, and didn't keep his testimonies, ⁵⁷but turned back, and dealt treacherously like their fathers. They were twisted like a deceitful bow. ⁵⁸For they provoked him to anger with their high places, and moved him to jealousy with their engraved images. ⁵⁹When God heard this, he was angry, and greatly ab-

horred Israel, ⁶⁰so that he abandoned the tent of Shiloh, the tent which he placed among men, ⁶¹and delivered his strength into captivity, his glory into the adversary's hand. ⁶²He also gave his people over to the sword, and was angry with his inheritance. ⁶³Fire devoured their young men. Their virgins had no wedding song. ⁶⁴Their priests fell by the sword, and their widows couldn't weep. ⁶⁵Then the Lord awakened as one out of sleep, like a mighty man who shouts by reason of wine. ⁶⁶He struck his adversaries backward. He put them to a perpetual reproach. ⁶⁷Moreover he rejected the tent of Joseph, and didn't choose the tribe of Ephraim, ⁶⁸But chose the tribe of Judah, Mount Zion which he loved. ⁶⁹He built his sanctuary like the heights, like the earth which he has established forever. ⁷⁰He also chose David his servant, and took him from the sheepfolds; ⁷¹from following the ewes that have their young, he brought him to be the shepherd of Jacob, his people, and Israel, his inheritance. ⁷²So he was their shepherd according to the integrity of his heart, and guided them by the skillfulness of his hands.

79God, the nations have come into your inheritance. They have defiled your holy temple. They have laid Jerusalem in heaps. ²They have given the dead bodies of your servants to be food for the birds of the sky, the flesh of your holy ones to the animals of the earth. ³They have shed their blood like water around Jerusalem. There was no one to bury them. ⁴We have become a reproach to our neighbors, a scoffing and derision to those who are around us. ⁵How long, LORD? Will you be angry forever? Will your jealousy burn like fire? ⁶Pour out your wrath on the nations that don't know you, on the kingdoms that don't call on your name, ⁷for they have devoured Jacob, and destroyed his homeland. ⁸Don't hold the iniquities of our forefathers against us. Let your tender mercies speedily meet us, for we are in desperate need. ⁹Help us, God of our salvation, for the glory of your name. Deliver us, and forgive our sins, for your name's sake. ¹⁰Why should the nations say, "Where is their God?" Let it be known among the nations, before our eyes, that vengeance for your servants' blood is being poured out. ¹¹Let the sighing of the prisoner come before you. According to the greatness of your power, preserve those who are sentenced to death. ¹²Pay back to our neighbors seven times into their bosom their reproach with which they have reproached you, Lord. ¹³So we, your people and sheep of your pasture, will give you thanks forever. We will praise you forever, to all generations.

80Hear us, Shepherd of Israel, you who lead Joseph like a flock, you who sit above the cherubim, shine out. ²Before Ephraim, Benjamin, and Manasseh, stir up your might! Come to save us! ³Turn us again, God. Cause your face to shine, and we will be saved. ⁴LORD God of

Hosts, how long will you be angry against the prayer of your people? ⁵You have fed them with the bread of tears, and given them tears to drink in large measure. ⁶You make us a source of contention to our neighbors. Our enemies laugh among themselves. ⁷Turn us again, God of Hosts. Cause your face to shine, and we will be saved. ⁸You brought a vine out of Egypt. You drove out the nations, and planted it. ⁹You cleared the ground for it. It took deep root, and filled the land. ¹⁰The mountains were covered with its shadow. Its boughs were like God's cedars. ¹¹It sent out its branches to the sea, its shoots to the River. ¹²Why have you broken down its walls, so that all those who pass by the way pluck it? ¹³The boar out of the wood ravages it. The wild animals of the field feed on it. ¹⁴Turn again, we beg you, God of Hosts. Look down from heaven, and see, and visit this vine, ¹⁵the stock which your right hand planted, the branch that you made strong for yourself. ¹⁶It's burned with fire. It's cut down. They perish at your rebuke. ¹⁷Let your hand be on the man of your right hand, on the son of man whom you made strong for yourself. ¹⁸So we will not turn away from you. Revive us, and we will call on your name. ¹⁹Turn us again, LORD God of Hosts. Cause your face to shine, and we will be saved.

81 Sing aloud to God, our strength! Make a joyful shout to the God of Jacob! ²Raise a song, and bring here the tambourine, the pleasant lyre with the harp. ³Blow the shofar at the New Moon, at the full moon, on our feast day. ⁴For it is a statute for Israel, an ordinance of the God of Jacob. ⁵He appointed it in Joseph for a covenant, when he went out over the land of Egypt, I heard a language that I didn't know. ⁶"I removed his shoulder from the burden. His hands were freed from the basket. ⁷You called in trouble, and I delivered you. I answered you in the secret place of thunder. I tested you at the waters of Meribah." ⁸"Hear, my people, and I will testify to you, Israel, if you would listen to me! ⁹There shall be no strange god in you, neither shall you worship any foreign god. ¹⁰I am the LORD, your God, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt. Open your mouth wide, and I will fill it. ¹¹But my people didn't listen to my voice. Israel desired none of me. ¹²So I let them go after the stubbornness of their hearts, that they might walk in their own counsels. ¹³Oh that my people would listen to me, that Israel would walk in my ways! ¹⁴I would soon subdue their enemies, and turn my hand against their adversaries. ¹⁵The haters of the LORD would cringe before him, and their punishment would last forever. ¹⁶But he would have also fed them with the finest of the wheat. I will satisfy you with honey out of the rock."

82 God presides in the great assembly. He judges among the gods. ²"How long will you judge unjustly, and show partiality to the wicked?" Selah. ³"Defend the weak, the

poor, and the fatherless. Maintain the rights of the poor and oppressed. ⁴Rescue the weak and needy. Deliver them out of the hand of the wicked." ⁵They don't know, neither do they understand. They walk back and forth in darkness. All the foundations of the earth are shaken. ⁶I said, "You are gods, all of you are sons of the Most High. ⁷Nevertheless you shall die like men, and fall like one of the rulers." ⁸Arise, God, judge the earth, for you inherit all of the nations.

83 God, don't keep silent. Don't keep silent, and don't be still, God. ²For, behold, your enemies are stirred up. Those who hate you have lifted up their heads. ³They conspire with cunning against your people. They plot against your cherished ones. ⁴"Come," they say, "let's destroy them as a nation, that the name of Israel may be remembered no more." ⁵For they have conspired together with one mind. They form an alliance against you. ⁶The tents of Edom and the Ishmaelites; Moab, and the Hagrites; ⁷Gebal, Ammon, and Amalek; Philistia with the inhabitants of Tyre; ⁸Assyria also is joined with them. They have helped the children of Lot. ⁹Do to them as you did to Midian, as to Sisera, as to Jabin, at the river Kishon; ¹⁰who perished at Endor, who became as dung for the earth. ¹¹Make their nobles like Oreb and Zeeb, yes, all their princes like Zebah and Zalmunna, ¹²who said, "Let's take possession of God's pasture lands." ¹³My God, make them like tumbleweed, like chaff before the wind. ¹⁴As the fire that burns the forest, as the flame that sets the mountains on fire, ¹⁵so pursue them with your tempest, and terrify them with your storm. ¹⁶Fill their faces with confusion, that they may seek your name, LORD. ¹⁷Let them be disappointed and dismayed forever. Yes, let them be confounded and perish; ¹⁸that they may know that you alone, whose name is the LORD, are the Most High over all the earth.

84 How lovely are your dwellings, LORD of Hosts! ²My soul longs, and even faints for the courts of the LORD. My heart and my flesh cry out for the living God. ³Yes, the sparrow has found a home, and the swallow a nest for herself, where she may have her young, near your altars, LORD of Hosts, my King, and my God. ⁴Blessed are those who dwell in your house. They are always praising you. ⁵Blessed are those whose strength is in you, who have set their hearts on a pilgrimage. ⁶Passing through the valley of Weeping, they make it a place of springs. Yes, the autumn rain covers it with blessings. ⁷They go from strength to strength. Every one of them appears before God in Zion. ⁸LORD, God of Hosts, hear my prayer. Listen, God of Jacob. ⁹Behold, God our shield, look at the face of your anointed. ¹⁰For a day in your courts is better than a thousand. I would rather be a doorkeeper in the house of my God, than to dwell in the tents of wickedness.

¹¹For the LORD God is a sun and a shield. The LORD will give grace and glory. He withholds no good thing from those who walk blamelessly. ¹²LORD of Hosts, blessed is the man who trusts in you.

85LORD, you have been favorable to your land. You have restored the fortunes of Jacob. ²You have forgiven the iniquity of your people. You have covered all their sin. ³You have taken away all your wrath. You have turned from the fierceness of your anger. ⁴Turn us, God of our salvation, and cause your indignation toward us to cease. ⁵Will you be angry with us forever? Will you draw out your anger to all generations? ⁶Won't you revive us again, that your people may rejoice in you? ⁷Show us your loving kindness, LORD. Grant us your salvation. ⁸I will hear what God, the LORD, will speak, for he will speak peace to his people, his holy ones; but let them not turn again to folly. ⁹Surely his salvation is near those who fear him, that glory may dwell in our land. ¹⁰Mercy and truth meet together. Righteousness and peace have kissed each other. ¹¹Truth springs out of the earth. Righteousness has looked down from heaven. ¹²Yes, the LORD will give that which is good. Our land will yield its increase. ¹³Righteousness goes before him, And prepares the way for his steps.

86Hear, LORD, and answer me, for I am poor and needy. ²Preserve my soul, for I am godly. You, my God, save your servant who trusts in you. ³Be merciful to me, Lord, for I call to you all day long. ⁴Bring joy to the soul of your servant, for to you, Lord, do I lift up my soul. ⁵For you, Lord, are good, and ready to forgive, abundant in loving kindness to all those who call on you. ⁶Hear, LORD, my prayer. Listen to the voice of my petitions. ⁷In the day of my trouble I will call on you, for you will answer me. ⁸There is no one like you among the gods, Lord, nor any deeds like your deeds. ⁹All nations you have made will come and worship before you, Lord. They shall glorify your name. ¹⁰For you are great, and do wondrous things. You are God alone. ¹¹Teach me your way, LORD. I will walk in your truth. Make my heart undivided to fear your name. ¹²I will praise you, Lord my God, with my whole heart. I will glorify your name forever more. ¹³For your loving kindness is great toward me. You have delivered my soul from the lowest Sheol. ^{xxvii} ¹⁴God, the proud have risen up against me. A company of violent men have sought after my soul, and they don't hold regard for you before them. ¹⁵But you, Lord, are a merciful and gracious God, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth. ¹⁶Turn to me, and have mercy on me! Give your strength to your servant. Save the son of your servant. ¹⁷Show me a sign of your goodness, that those who hate me may see it, and be shamed, because you, LORD, have helped me, and comforted me.

^{xxvii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

87His foundation is in the holy mountains. ²The LORD loves the gates of Zion more than all the dwellings of Jacob. ³Glorious things are spoken about you, city of God. Selah. ⁴I will record Rahab ^{xxviii} and Babylon among those who acknowledge me. Behold, Philistia, Tyre, and also Ethiopia: "This one was born there." ⁵Yes, of Zion it will be said, "This one and that one was born in her;" the Most High himself will establish her. ⁶The LORD will count, when he writes up the peoples, "This one was born there." Selah. ⁷Those who sing as well as those who dance say, "All my springs are in you."

88LORD, the God of my salvation, I have cried day and night before you. ²Let my prayer enter into your presence. Turn your ear to my cry. ³For my soul is full of troubles. My life draws near to Sheol. ^{xxix} ⁴I am counted among those who go down into the pit. I am like a man who has no help, ⁵set apart among the dead, like the slain who lie in the grave, whom you remember no more. They are cut off from your hand. ⁶You have laid me in the lowest pit, in the darkest depths. ⁷Your wrath lies heavily on me. You have afflicted me with all your waves. ⁸You have taken my friends from me. You have made me an abomination to them. I am confined, and I can't escape. ⁹My eyes are dim from grief. I have called on you daily, LORD. I have spread out my hands to you. ¹⁰Do you show wonders to the dead? Do the departed spirits rise up and praise you? ¹¹Is your loving kindness declared in the grave? Or your faithfulness in Destruction? ¹²Are your wonders made known in the dark? Or your righteousness in the land of forgetfulness? ¹³But to you, LORD, I have cried. In the morning, my prayer comes before you. ¹⁴LORD, why do you reject my soul? Why do you hide your face from me? ¹⁵I am afflicted and ready to die from my youth up. While I suffer your terrors, I am distracted. ¹⁶Your fierce wrath has gone over me. Your terrors have cut me off. ¹⁷They came around me like water all day long. They completely engulfed me. ¹⁸You have put lover and friend far from me, and my friends into darkness.

89I will sing of the loving kindness of the LORD forever. With my mouth, I will make known your faithfulness to all generations. ²I indeed declare, "Love stands firm forever. You established the heavens. Your faithfulness is in them." ³"I have made a covenant with my chosen one, I have sworn to David, my servant, ⁴I will establish your offspring forever, and build up your throne to all generations.'" ⁵The heavens will praise your wonders, LORD, your faithfulness also in the assembly of the holy ones. ⁶For who in the skies can be compared to the LORD? Who among the sons of the heavenly beings is like the LORD, ⁷a very awesome

^{xxviii}Rahab is a reference to Egypt.

^{xxix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

God in the council of the holy ones, to be feared above all those who are around him? ⁸LORD, God of Hosts, who is a mighty one, like you? The LORD, your faithfulness is around you. ⁹You rule the pride of the sea. When its waves rise up, you calm them. ¹⁰You have broken Rahab in pieces, like one of the slain. You have scattered your enemies with your mighty arm. ¹¹The heavens are yours. The earth also is yours, the world and its fullness. You have founded them. ¹²You have created the north and the south. Tabor and Hermon rejoice in your name. ¹³You have a mighty arm. Your hand is strong, and your right hand is exalted. ¹⁴Righteousness and justice are the foundation of your throne. Loving kindness and truth go before your face. ¹⁵Blessed are the people who learn to acclaim you. They walk in the light of your presence, LORD. ¹⁶In your name they rejoice all day. In your righteousness, they are exalted. ¹⁷For you are the glory of their strength. In your favor, our horn will be exalted. ¹⁸For our shield belongs to the LORD, our king to the Holy One of Israel. ¹⁹Then you spoke in vision to your holy ones, and said, "I have given strength to the warrior. I have exalted a young man from the people. ²⁰I have found David, my servant. I have anointed him with my holy oil, ²¹with whom my hand shall be established. My arm will also strengthen him. ²²No enemy will tax him. No wicked man will oppress him. ²³I will beat down his adversaries before him, and strike those who hate him. ²⁴But my faithfulness and my loving kindness will be with him. In my name, his horn will be exalted. ²⁵I will set his hand also on the sea, and his right hand on the rivers. ²⁶He will call to me, 'You are my Father, my God, and the rock of my salvation!' ²⁷I will also appoint him my firstborn, the highest of the kings of the earth. ²⁸I will keep my loving kindness for him forever more. My covenant will stand firm with him. ²⁹I will also make his offspring endure forever, and his throne as the days of heaven. ³⁰If his children forsake my Torah, and don't walk in my ordinances; ³¹if they break my statutes, and don't keep my commandments; ³²then I will punish their sin with the rod, and their iniquity with stripes. ³³But I will not completely take my loving kindness from him, nor allow my faithfulness to fail. ³⁴I will not break my covenant, nor alter what my lips have uttered. ³⁵Once I have sworn by my holiness, I will not lie to David. ³⁶His offspring will endure forever, his throne like the sun before me. ³⁷It will be established forever like the moon, the faithful witness in the sky." ³⁸But you have rejected and spurned. You have been angry with your anointed. ³⁹You have renounced the covenant of your servant. You have defiled his crown in the dust. ⁴⁰You have broken down all his hedges. You have brought his strongholds to ruin. ⁴¹All who pass by the way rob him. He has become a reproach to his neighbors. ⁴²You have exalted the right hand of his adversaries. You have made all of his enemies rejoice. ⁴³Yes, you turn back the edge

of his sword, and haven't supported him in battle. ⁴⁴You have ended his splendor, and thrown his throne down to the ground. ⁴⁵You have shortened the days of his youth. You have covered him with shame. ⁴⁶How long, LORD? Will you hide yourself forever? Will your wrath burn like fire? ⁴⁷Remember how short my time is, for what vanity you have created all the children of men! ⁴⁸What man is he who shall live and not see death, who shall deliver his soul from the power of Sheol? ^{xxx} ⁴⁹Lord, where are your former loving kindnesses, which you swore to David in your faithfulness? ⁵⁰Remember, Lord, the reproach of your servants, how I bear in my heart the taunts of all the mighty peoples, ⁵¹With which your enemies have mocked, LORD, with which they have mocked the footsteps of your anointed one. ⁵²Blessed be the LORD forever more. Amen, and Amen.

90Lord, ^{xxxi} you have been our dwelling place for all generations. ²Before the mountains were born, before you had formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, you are God. ³You turn man to destruction, saying, "Return, you children of men." ⁴For a thousand years in your sight are just like yesterday when it is past, like a watch in the night. ⁵You sweep them away as they sleep. In the morning they sprout like new grass. ⁶In the morning it sprouts and springs up. By evening, it is withered and dry. ⁷For we are consumed in your anger. We are troubled in your wrath. ⁸You have set our iniquities before you, our secret sins in the light of your presence. ⁹For all our days have passed away in your wrath. We bring our years to an end as a sigh. ¹⁰The days of our years are seventy, or even by reason of strength eighty years; yet their pride is but labor and sorrow, for it passes quickly, and we fly away. ¹¹Who knows the power of your anger, your wrath according to the fear that is due to you? ¹²So teach us to count our days, that we may gain a heart of wisdom. ¹³Relent, LORD! ^{xxxii} How long? Have compassion on your servants! ¹⁴Satisfy us in the morning with your loving kindness, that we may rejoice and be glad all our days. ¹⁵Make us glad for as many days as you have afflicted us, for as many years as we have seen evil. ¹⁶Let your work appear to your servants, your glory to their children. ¹⁷Let the favor of the Lord our God be on us. Establish the work of our hands for us. Yes, establish the work of our hands.

91He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High will rest in the shadow of the Almighty. ²I will say of the LORD, "He is my refuge and my fortress; my God, in whom I trust." ³For he will deliver you from the snare of the fowler, and from the deadly pestilence. ⁴He will cover

^{xxx}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xxxi}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{xxxii}When rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

you with his feathers. Under his wings you will take refuge. His faithfulness is your shield and rampart. ⁵You shall not be afraid of the terror by night, nor of the arrow that flies by day, ⁶nor of the pestilence that walks in darkness, nor of the destruction that wastes at noonday. ⁷A thousand may fall at your side, and ten thousand at your right hand; but it will not come near you. ⁸You will only look with your eyes, and see the recompense of the wicked. ⁹Because you have made the LORD your refuge, and the Most High your dwelling place, ¹⁰no evil shall happen to you, neither shall any plague come near your dwelling. ¹¹For he will put his angels in charge of you, to guard you in all your ways. ¹²They will bear you up in their hands, so that you won't dash your foot against a stone. ¹³You will tread on the lion and cobra. You will trample the young lion and the serpent underfoot. ¹⁴"Because he has set his love on me, therefore I will deliver him. I will set him on high, because he has known my name. ¹⁵He will call on me, and I will answer him. I will be with him in trouble. I will deliver him, and honor him. ¹⁶I will satisfy him with long life, and show him my salvation [yeshuah-ti]."

92It is a good thing to give thanks to the LORD, to sing praises to your name, Most High, ²to proclaim your loving kindness in the morning, and your faithfulness every night, ³with the ten-stringed lute, with the harp, and with the melody of the lyre. ⁴For you, LORD, have made me glad through your work. I will triumph in the works of your hands. ⁵How great are your works, LORD! Your thoughts are very deep. ⁶A senseless man doesn't know, neither does a fool understand this: ⁷though the wicked spring up as the grass, and all the evildoers flourish, they will be destroyed forever. ⁸But you, LORD, are on high forever more. ⁹For behold, your enemies, LORD, for behold, your enemies shall perish. All the evildoers will be scattered. ¹⁰But you have exalted my horn like that of the wild ox. I am anointed with fresh oil. ¹¹My eye has also seen my enemies. My ears have heard of the wicked enemies who rise up against me. ¹²The righteous shall flourish like the palm tree. He will grow like a cedar in Lebanon. ¹³They are planted in the LORD's house. They will flourish in our God's courts. ¹⁴They will still produce fruit in old age. They will be full of sap and green, ¹⁵to show that the LORD is upright. He is my rock, and there is no unrighteousness in him.

93The LORD reigns! He is clothed with majesty! The LORD is armed with strength. The world also is established. It can't be moved. ²Your throne is established from long ago. You are from everlasting. ³The floods have lifted up, LORD, the floods have lifted up their voice. The floods lift up their waves. ⁴Above the voices of many waters, the mighty breakers of the sea, The LORD on high is mighty. ⁵Your statutes stand firm. Holiness adorns your

house, LORD, forever more.

94LORD, you God to whom vengeance belongs, you God to whom vengeance belongs, shine out. ²Rise up, you judge of the earth. Pay back the proud what they deserve. ³LORD, how long will the wicked, how long will the wicked triumph? ⁴They pour out arrogant words. All the evildoers boast. ⁵They break your people in pieces, LORD, and afflict your heritage. ⁶They kill the widow and the alien, and murder the fatherless. ⁷They say, "The LORD will not see, neither will Jacob's God consider." ⁸Consider, you senseless among the people; you fools, when will you be wise? ⁹He who implanted the ear, won't he hear? He who formed the eye, won't he see? ¹⁰He who disciplines the nations, won't he punish? He who teaches man knows. ¹¹The LORD knows the thoughts of man, that they are futile. ¹²Blessed is the man whom you discipline, LORD, and teach out of your Torah, ¹³that you may give him rest from the days of adversity, until the pit is dug for the wicked. ¹⁴For the LORD won't reject his people, neither will he forsake his inheritance. ¹⁵For judgment will return to righteousness. All the upright in heart shall follow it. ¹⁶Who will rise up for me against the wicked? Who will stand up for me against the evildoers? ¹⁷Unless the LORD had been my help, my soul would have soon lived in silence. ¹⁸When I said, "My foot is slipping!" Your loving kindness, LORD, held me up. ¹⁹In the multitude of my thoughts within me, your comforts delight my soul. ²⁰Shall the throne of wickedness have fellowship with you, which brings about mischief by statute? ²¹They gather themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and condemn the innocent blood. ²²But the LORD has been my high tower, my God, the rock of my refuge. ²³He has brought on them their own iniquity, and will cut them off in their own wickedness. The LORD, our God, will cut them off.

95Oh come, let's sing to the LORD. Let's shout aloud to the rock of our salvation! ²Let's come before his presence with thanksgiving. Let's extol him with songs! ³For the LORD is a great God, a great King above all gods. ⁴In his hand are the deep places of the earth. The heights of the mountains are also his. ⁵The sea is his, and he made it. His hands formed the dry land. ⁶Oh come, let's worship and bow down. Let's kneel before the LORD, our Maker, ⁷for he is our God. We are the people of his pasture, and the sheep in his care. Today, oh that you would hear his voice! ⁸Don't harden your heart, as at Meribah, as in the day of Massah in the wilderness, ⁹when your fathers tempted me, tested me, and saw my work. ¹⁰Forty long years I was grieved with that generation, and said, "They are a people who err in their heart. They have not known my ways." ¹¹Therefore I swore in my wrath, "They won't enter into my rest."

96 Sing to the LORD a new song! Sing to the LORD, all the earth. ²Sing to the LORD! Bless his name! Proclaim his salvation from day to day! ³Declare his glory among the nations, his marvelous works among all the peoples. ⁴For the LORD is great, and greatly to be praised! He is to be feared above all gods. ⁵For all the gods of the peoples are idols, but the LORD made the heavens. ⁶Honor and majesty are before him. Strength and beauty are in his sanctuary. ⁷Ascribe to the LORD, you families of nations, ascribe to the LORD glory and strength. ⁸Ascribe to the LORD the glory due to his name. Bring an offering, and come into his courts. ⁹Worship the LORD in holy array. Tremble before him, all the earth. ¹⁰Say among the nations, "The LORD reigns." The world is also established. It can't be moved. He will judge the peoples with equity. ¹¹Let the heavens be glad, and let the earth rejoice. Let the sea roar, and its fullness! ¹²Let the field and all that is in it exult! Then all the trees of the woods shall sing for joy ¹³before the LORD; for he comes, for he comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world with righteousness, the peoples with his truth.

97 The LORD reigns! Let the earth rejoice! Let the multitude of islands be glad! ²Clouds and darkness are around him. Righteousness and justice are the foundation of his throne. ³A fire goes before him, and burns up his adversaries on every side. ⁴His lightning lights up the world. The earth sees, and trembles. ⁵The mountains melt like wax at the presence of the LORD, at the presence of the Lord of the whole earth. ⁶The heavens declare his righteousness. All the peoples have seen his glory. ⁷Let all them be shamed who serve engraved images, who boast in their idols. Worship him, all you gods! ^{xxxiii} ⁸Zion heard and was glad. The daughters of Judah rejoiced because of your judgments, LORD. ⁹For you, LORD, are most high above all the earth. You are exalted far above all gods. ¹⁰You who love the LORD, hate evil! He preserves the souls of his holy ones. He delivers them out of the hand of the wicked. ¹¹Light is sown for the righteous, and gladness for the upright in heart. ¹²Be glad in the LORD, you righteous people! Give thanks to his holy Name.

98 Sing to the LORD a new song, for he has done marvelous things! His right hand and his holy arm have worked salvation for him. ²The LORD has made known his salvation. He has openly shown his righteousness in the sight of the nations. ³He has remembered his loving kindness and his faithfulness toward the house of Israel. All the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God. ⁴Make a joyful noise to the LORD, all the earth! Burst out and sing for joy, yes, sing praises! ⁵Sing praises to the LORD with the harp, with the harp and the voice of melody. ⁶With sho-

fars ^{xxxiv} or, trumpets and sound of the ram's horn, make a joyful noise before the King, the LORD. ⁷Let the sea roar with its fullness; the world, and those who dwell therein. ⁸Let the rivers clap their hands. Let the mountains sing for joy together. ⁹Let them sing before the LORD, for he comes to judge the earth. He will judge the world with righteousness, and the peoples with equity.

99 The LORD reigns! Let the peoples tremble. He sits enthroned among the cherubim. Let the earth be moved. ²The LORD is great in Zion. He is high above all the peoples. ³Let them praise your great and awesome name. He is Holy! ⁴The King's strength also loves justice. You establish equity. You execute justice and righteousness in Jacob. ⁵Exalt the LORD our God. Worship at his footstool. He is Holy! ⁶Moses and Aaron were among his priests, Samuel was among those who call on his name. They called on the LORD, and he answered them. ⁷He spoke to them in the pillar of cloud. They kept his testimonies, the statute that he gave them. ⁸You answered them, LORD our God. You are a God who forgave them, although you took vengeance for their doings. ⁹Exalt the LORD, our God. Worship at his holy hill, for the LORD, our God, is holy!

100 Shout for joy to the LORD, all you lands! ²Serve the LORD with gladness. Come before his presence with singing. ³Know that the LORD, he is God. It is he who has made us, and we are his. We are his people, and the sheep of his pasture. ⁴Enter into his gates with thanksgiving, and into his courts with praise. Give thanks to him, and bless his name. ⁵For the LORD is good. His loving kindness endures forever, his faithfulness to all generations.

101 I will sing of loving kindness and justice. To you, LORD, I will sing praises. ²I will be careful to live a blameless life. When will you come to me? I will walk within my house with a blameless heart. ³I will set no vile thing before my eyes. I hate the deeds of faithless men. They will not cling to me. ⁴A perverse heart will be far from me. I will have nothing to do with evil. ⁵I will silence whoever secretly slanders his neighbor. I won't tolerate one who is arrogant and conceited. ⁶My eyes will be on the faithful of the land, that they may dwell with me. He who walks in a perfect way, he will serve me. ⁷He who practices deceit won't dwell within my house. He who speaks falsehood won't be established before my eyes. ⁸Morning by morning, I will destroy all the wicked of the land, to cut off all the workers of iniquity from the LORD's city.

102 Hear my prayer, LORD! Let my cry come to you. ²Don't hide your face from me in the day of my distress. Turn your ear to me. Answer me quickly in the day when

^{xxxiii} LXX reads "angels" instead of "gods".

^{xxxiv} or, trumpets

I call. ³For my days consume away like smoke. My bones are burned as a torch. ⁴My heart is blighted like grass, and withered, for I forget to eat my bread. ⁵By reason of the voice of my groaning, my bones stick to my skin. ⁶I am like a pelican of the wilderness. I have become as an owl of the waste places. ⁷I watch, and have become like a sparrow that is alone on the housetop. ⁸My enemies reproach me all day. Those who are mad at me use my name as a curse. ⁹For I have eaten ashes like bread, and mixed my drink with tears, ¹⁰because of your indignation and your wrath; for you have taken me up and thrown me away. ¹¹My days are like a long shadow. I have withered like grass. ¹²But you, LORD, will remain forever; your renown endures to all generations. ¹³You will arise and have mercy on Zion, for it is time to have pity on her. Yes, the set time has come. ¹⁴For your servants take pleasure in her stones, and have pity on her dust. ¹⁵So the nations will fear the LORD's name, all the kings of the earth your glory. ¹⁶For the LORD has built up Zion. He has appeared in his glory. ¹⁷He has responded to the prayer of the destitute, and has not despised their prayer. ¹⁸This will be written for the generation to come. A people which will be created will praise the LORD, ¹⁹for he has looked down from the height of his sanctuary. From heaven, the LORD saw the earth, ²⁰to hear the groans of the prisoner, to free those who are condemned to death, ²¹that men may declare the LORD's name in Zion, and his praise in Jerusalem, ²²when the peoples are gathered together, the kingdoms, to serve the LORD. ²³He weakened my strength along the course. He shortened my days. ²⁴I said, "My God, don't take me away in the middle of my days. Your years are throughout all generations. ²⁵Of old, you laid the foundation of the earth. The heavens are the work of your hands. ²⁶They will perish, but you will endure. Yes, all of them will wear out like a garment. You will change them like a cloak, and they will be changed. ²⁷But you are the same. Your years will have no end. ²⁸The children of your servants will continue. Their offspring will be established before you."

103 Praise the LORD, my soul! All that is within me, praise his holy name! ²Praise the LORD, my soul, and don't forget all his benefits, ³who forgives all your sins, who heals all your diseases, ⁴who redeems your life from destruction, who crowns you with loving kindness and tender mercies, ⁵who satisfies your desire with good things, so that your youth is renewed like the eagle's. ⁶The LORD executes righteous acts, and justice for all who are oppressed. ⁷He made known his ways to Moses, his deeds to the children of Israel. ⁸The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness. ⁹He will not always accuse; neither will he stay angry forever. ¹⁰He has not dealt with us according to our sins, nor repaid us for our iniquities. ¹¹For as the heavens are high above the earth, so great is his loving kindness toward those who

fear him. ¹²As far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us. ¹³Like a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear him. ¹⁴For he knows how we are made. He remembers that we are dust. ¹⁵As for man, his days are like grass. As a flower of the field, so he flourishes. ¹⁶For the wind passes over it, and it is gone. Its place remembers it no more. ¹⁷But the LORD's loving kindness is from everlasting to everlasting with those who fear him, his righteousness to children's children, ¹⁸to those who keep his covenant, to those who remember to obey his precepts. ¹⁹The LORD has established his throne in the heavens. His kingdom rules over all. ²⁰Praise the LORD, you angels of his, who are mighty in strength, who fulfill his word, obeying the voice of his word. ²¹Praise the LORD, all you armies of his, you servants of his, who do his pleasure. ²²Praise the LORD, all you works of his, in all places of his dominion. Praise the LORD, my soul!

104 Bless the LORD, my soul. The LORD, my God, you are very great. You are clothed with honor and majesty. ²He covers himself with light as with a garment. He stretches out the heavens like a curtain. ³He lays the beams of his rooms in the waters. He makes the clouds his chariot. He walks on the wings of the wind. ⁴He makes his messengers ^{xxxv} winds, and his servants flames of fire. ⁵He laid the foundations of the earth, that it should not be moved forever. ⁶You covered it with the deep as with a cloak. The waters stood above the mountains. ⁷At your rebuke they fled. At the voice of your thunder they hurried away. ⁸The mountains rose, the valleys sank down, to the place which you had assigned to them. ⁹You have set a boundary that they may not pass over, that they don't turn again to cover the earth. ¹⁰He sends springs into the valleys. They run among the mountains. ¹¹They give drink to every animal of the field. The wild donkeys quench their thirst. ¹²The birds of the sky nest by them. They sing among the branches. ¹³He waters the mountains from his rooms. The earth is filled with the fruit of your works. ¹⁴He causes the grass to grow for the livestock, and plants for man to cultivate, that he may produce food out of the earth: ¹⁵wine that makes the heart of man glad, oil to make his face to shine, and bread that strengthens man's heart. ¹⁶The LORD's trees are well watered, the cedars of Lebanon, which he has planted, ¹⁷where the birds make their nests. The stork makes its home in the cypress trees. ¹⁸The high mountains are for the wild goats. The rocks are a refuge for the rock badgers. ¹⁹He appointed the moon for seasons. The sun knows when to set. ²⁰You make darkness, and it is night, in which all the animals of the forest prowl. ²¹The young lions roar after their prey, and seek their food from God. ²²The sun rises, and they steal away, and lie down in their dens. ²³Man goes out to his work,

^{xxxv}or, angels

to his labor until the evening. ²⁴The LORD, how many are your works! In wisdom, you have made them all. The earth is full of your riches. ²⁵There is the sea, great and wide, in which are innumerable living things, both small and large animals. ²⁶There the ships go, and leviathan, whom you formed to play there. ²⁷These all wait for you, that you may give them their food in due season. ²⁸You give to them; they gather. You open your hand; they are satisfied with good. ²⁹You hide your face; they are troubled. You take away their breath; they die and return to the dust. ³⁰You send out your Spirit and they are created. You renew the face of the ground. ³¹Let the LORD's glory endure forever. Let the LORD rejoice in his works. ³²He looks at the earth, and it trembles. He touches the mountains, and they smoke. ³³I will sing to the LORD as long as I live. I will sing praise to my God while I have any being. ³⁴Let my meditation be sweet to him. I will rejoice in the LORD. ³⁵Let sinners be consumed out of the earth. Let the wicked be no more. Bless the LORD, my soul. Praise the LORD!

105 Give thanks to the LORD! Call on his name! Make his doings known among the peoples. ²Sing to him, sing praises to him! Tell of all his marvelous works. ³Glory in his holy name. Let the heart of those who seek the LORD rejoice. ⁴Seek the LORD and his strength. Seek his face forever more. ⁵Remember his marvelous works that he has done: his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth, ⁶you offspring of Abraham, his servant, you children of Jacob, his chosen ones. ⁷He is the LORD, our God. His judgments are in all the earth. ⁸He has remembered his covenant forever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations, ⁹the covenant which he made with Abraham, his oath to Isaac, ¹⁰and confirmed it to Jacob for a statute; to Israel for an everlasting covenant, ¹¹saying, "To you I will give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance," ¹²when they were but a few men in number, yes, very few, and foreigners in it. ¹³They went about from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another people. ¹⁴He allowed no one to do them wrong. Yes, he reproved kings for their sakes, ¹⁵"Don't touch my anointed ones! Do my prophets no harm!" ¹⁶He called for a famine on the land. He destroyed the food supplies. ¹⁷He sent a man before them. Joseph was sold for a slave. ¹⁸They bruised his feet with shackles. His neck was locked in irons, ¹⁹until the time that his word happened, and the LORD's word proved him true. ²⁰The king sent and freed him, even the ruler of peoples, and let him go free. ²¹He made him lord of his house, and ruler of all of his possessions, ²²to discipline his princes at his pleasure, and to teach his elders wisdom. ²³Israel also came into Egypt. Jacob lived in the land of Ham. ²⁴He increased his people greatly, and made them stronger than their adversaries. ²⁵He turned their heart to hate his people, to conspire against his servants. ²⁶He

sent Moses, his servant, and Aaron, whom he had chosen. ²⁷They performed miracles among them, and wonders in the land of Ham. ²⁸He sent darkness, and made it dark. They didn't rebel against his words. ²⁹He turned their waters into blood, and killed their fish. ³⁰Their land swarmed with frogs, even in the rooms of their kings. ³¹He spoke, and swarms of flies came, and lice in all their borders. ³²He gave them hail for rain, with lightning in their land. ³³He struck their vines and also their fig trees, and shattered the trees of their country. ³⁴He spoke, and the locusts came with the grasshoppers, without number. ³⁵They ate up every plant in their land, and ate up the fruit of their ground. ³⁶He struck also all the firstborn in their land, the first fruits of all their manhood. ³⁷He brought them out with silver and gold. There was not one feeble person among his tribes. ³⁸Egypt was glad when they departed, for the fear of them had fallen on them. ³⁹He spread a cloud for a covering, fire to give light in the night. ⁴⁰They asked, and he brought quails, and satisfied them with the bread of the sky. ⁴¹He opened the rock, and waters gushed out. They ran as a river in the dry places. ⁴²For he remembered his holy word, and Abraham, his servant. ⁴³He brought his people out with joy, his chosen with singing. ⁴⁴He gave them the lands of the nations. They took the labor of the peoples in possession, ⁴⁵that they might keep his statutes, and observe his laws. Praise the LORD!

106 Praise the LORD! Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever. ²Who can utter the mighty acts of the LORD, or fully declare all his praise? ³Blessed are those who keep justice. Blessed is one who does what is right at all times. ⁴Remember me, LORD, with the favor that you show to your people. Visit me with your salvation, ⁵that I may see the prosperity of your chosen, that I may rejoice in the gladness of your nation, that I may glory with your inheritance. ⁶We have sinned with our fathers. We have committed iniquity. We have done wickedly. ⁷Our fathers didn't understand your wonders in Egypt. They didn't remember the multitude of your loving kindnesses, but were rebellious at the sea, even at the Sea of Suf. ⁸Nevertheless he saved them for his name's sake, that he might make his mighty power known. ⁹He rebuked the Sea of Suf also, and it was dried up; so he led them through the depths, as through a desert. ¹⁰He saved them from the hand of him who hated them, and redeemed them from the hand of the enemy. ¹¹The waters covered their adversaries. There was not one of them left. ¹²Then they believed his words. They sang his praise. ¹³They soon forgot his works. They didn't wait for his counsel, ¹⁴but gave in to craving in the desert, and tested God in the wasteland. ¹⁵He gave them their request, but sent leanness into their soul. ¹⁶They envied Moses also in the camp, and Aaron, the LORD's holy one. ¹⁷The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan,

and covered the company of Abiram. ¹⁸A fire was kindled in their company. The flame burned up the wicked. ¹⁹They made a calf in Horeb, and worshiped a molten image. ²⁰Thus they exchanged their glory for an image of a bull that eats grass. ²¹They forgot God, their Savior, who had done great things in Egypt, ²²wondrous works in the land of Ham, and awesome things by the Sea of Suf. ²³Therefore he said that he would destroy them, had Moses, his chosen, not stood before him in the breach, to turn away his wrath, so that he wouldn't destroy them. ²⁴Yes, they despised the pleasant land. They didn't believe his word, ²⁵but murmured in their tents, and didn't listen to the LORD's voice. ²⁶Therefore he swore to them that he would overthrow them in the wilderness, ²⁷that he would overthrow their offspring among the nations, and scatter them in the lands. ²⁸They joined themselves also to Baal Peor, and ate the sacrifices of the dead. ²⁹Thus they provoked him to anger with their deeds. The plague broke in on them. ³⁰Then Phinehas stood up and executed judgment, so the plague was stopped. ³¹That was credited to him for righteousness, for all generations to come. ³²They angered him also at the waters of Meribah, so that Moses was troubled for their sakes; ³³because they were rebellious against his spirit, he spoke rashly with his lips. ³⁴They didn't destroy the peoples, as the LORD commanded them, ³⁵but mixed themselves with the nations, and learned their works. ³⁶They served their idols, which became a snare to them. ³⁷Yes, they sacrificed their sons and their daughters to demons. ³⁸They shed innocent blood, even the blood of their sons and of their daughters, whom they sacrificed to the idols of Canaan. The land was polluted with blood. ³⁹Thus they were defiled with their works, and prostituted themselves in their deeds. ⁴⁰Therefore the LORD burned with anger against his people. He abhorred his inheritance. ⁴¹He gave them into the hand of the nations. Those who hated them ruled over them. ⁴²Their enemies also oppressed them. They were brought into subjection under their hand. ⁴³He rescued them many times, but they were rebellious in their counsel, and were brought low in their iniquity. ⁴⁴Nevertheless he regarded their distress, when he heard their cry. ⁴⁵He remembered for them his covenant, and repented according to the multitude of his loving kindnesses. ⁴⁶He made them also to be pitied by all those who carried them captive. ⁴⁷Save us, LORD, our God, gather us from among the nations, to give thanks to your holy name, to triumph in your praise! ⁴⁸Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting even to everlasting! Let all the people say, "Amen." Praise the LORD!

107 Give thanks to the LORD, ^{xxxvi} for he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever. ²Let the redeemed by

^{xxxvi}When rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

the LORD say so, whom he has redeemed from the hand of the adversary, ³and gathered out of the lands, from the east and from the west, from the north and from the south. ⁴They wandered in the wilderness in a desert way. They found no city to live in. ⁵Hungry and thirsty, their soul fainted in them. ⁶Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and he delivered them out of their distresses. ⁷He led them also by a straight way, that they might go to a city to live in. ⁸Let them praise the LORD for his loving kindness, for his wonderful deeds to the children of men! ⁹For he satisfies the longing soul. He fills the hungry soul with good. ¹⁰Some sat in darkness and in the shadow of death, being bound in affliction and iron, ¹¹because they rebelled against the words of God, ^{xxxvii} and condemned the counsel of the Most High. ¹²Therefore he brought down their heart with labor. They fell down, and there was no one to help. ¹³Then they cried to the LORD in their trouble, and he saved them out of their distresses. ¹⁴He brought them out of darkness and the shadow of death, and broke away their chains. ¹⁵Let them praise the LORD for his loving kindness, for his wonderful deeds to the children of men! ¹⁶For he has broken the gates of bronze, and cut through bars of iron. ¹⁷Fools are afflicted because of their disobedience, and because of their iniquities. ¹⁸Their soul abhors all kinds of food. They draw near to the gates of death. ¹⁹Then they cry to the LORD in their trouble, and he saves them out of their distresses. ²⁰He sends his word, and heals them, and delivers them from their graves. ²¹Let them praise the LORD for his loving kindness, for his wonderful deeds to the children of men! ²²Let them offer the sacrifices of thanksgiving, and declare his deeds with singing. ²³Those who go down to the sea in ships, who do business in great waters, ²⁴these see the LORD's deeds, and his wonders in the deep. ²⁵For he commands, and raises the stormy wind, which lifts up its waves. ²⁶They mount up to the sky; they go down again to the depths. Their soul melts away because of trouble. ²⁷They reel back and forth, and stagger like a drunken man, and are at their wits' end. ²⁸Then they cry to the LORD in their trouble, and he brings them out of their distress. ²⁹He makes the storm a calm, so that its waves are still. ³⁰Then they are glad because it is calm, so he brings them to their desired haven. ³¹Let them praise the LORD for his loving kindness, for his wonderful deeds for the children of men! ³²Let them exalt him also in the assembly of the people, and praise him in the seat of the elders. ³³He turns rivers into a desert, water springs into a thirsty ground, ³⁴and a fruitful land into a salt waste, for the wickedness of those who dwell in it. ³⁵He turns a desert into a pool of water, and a dry land into water springs. ³⁶There he makes the hungry live, that they may prepare a city to live in, ³⁷sow fields, plant vineyards, and reap the fruits of increase. ³⁸He blesses them also, so that they are multiplied greatly. He

^{xxxviii}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

doesn't allow their livestock to decrease. ³⁹Again, they are diminished and bowed down through oppression, trouble, and sorrow. ⁴⁰He pours contempt on princes, and causes them to wander in a trackless waste. ⁴¹Yet he lifts the needy out of their affliction, and increases their families like a flock. ⁴²The upright will see it, and be glad. All the wicked will shut their mouths. ⁴³Whoever is wise will pay attention to these things. They will consider the loving kindnesses of the LORD.

108My heart is steadfast, God. I will sing and I will make music with my soul. ²Wake up, harp and lyre! I will wake up the dawn. ³I will give thanks to you, LORD, among the nations. I will sing praises to you among the peoples. ⁴For your loving kindness is great above the heavens. Your faithfulness reaches to the skies. ⁵Be exalted, God, above the heavens! Let your glory be over all the earth. ⁶That your beloved may be delivered, save with your right hand, and answer us. ⁷God has spoken from his sanctuary: "In triumph, I will divide Shechem, and measure out the valley of Succoth. ⁸Gilead is mine. Manasseh is mine. Ephraim also is my helmet. Judah is my scepter. ⁹Moab is my wash pot. I will toss my sandal on Edom. I will shout over Philistia." ¹⁰Who will bring me into the fortified city? Who will lead me to Edom? ¹¹Haven't you rejected us, God? You don't go out, God, with our armies. ¹²Give us help against the enemy, for the help of man is vain. ¹³Through God, we will do valiantly, for it is he who will tread down our enemies.

109God of my praise, don't remain silent, ²for they have opened the mouth of the wicked and the mouth of deceit against me. They have spoken to me with a lying tongue. ³They have also surrounded me with words of hatred, and fought against me without a cause. ⁴In return for my love, they are my adversaries; but I am in prayer. ⁵They have rewarded me evil for good, and hatred for my love. ⁶Set a wicked man over him. Let an adversary stand at his right hand. ⁷When he is judged, let him come out guilty. Let his prayer be turned into sin. ⁸Let his days be few. Let another take his office. ⁹Let his children be fatherless, and his wife a widow. ¹⁰Let his children be wandering beggars. Let them be sought from their ruins. ¹¹Let the creditor seize all that he has. Let strangers plunder the fruit of his labor. ¹²Let there be no one to extend kindness to him, neither let there be anyone to have pity on his fatherless children. ¹³Let his posterity be cut off. In the generation following let their name be blotted out. ¹⁴Let the iniquity of his fathers be remembered by the LORD. Don't let the sin of his mother be blotted out. ¹⁵Let them be before the LORD continually, that he may cut off their memory from the earth; ¹⁶because he didn't remember to show kindness, but persecuted the poor and needy man, the broken in heart, to kill them. ¹⁷Yes, he loved cursing,

and it came to him. He didn't delight in blessing, and it was far from him. ¹⁸He clothed himself also with cursing as with his garment. It came into his inward parts like water, like oil into his bones. ¹⁹Let it be to him as the clothing with which he covers himself, for the belt that is always around him. ²⁰This is the reward of my adversaries from the LORD, of those who speak evil against my soul. ²¹But deal with me, GOD the Lord, ^{xxxviii} for your name's sake, because your loving kindness is good, deliver me; ²²for I am poor and needy. My heart is wounded within me. ²³I fade away like an evening shadow. I am shaken off like a locust. ²⁴My knees are weak through fasting. My body is thin and lacks fat. ²⁵I have also become a reproach to them. When they see me, they shake their head. ²⁶Help me, LORD, my God. Save me according to your loving kindness; ²⁷that they may know that this is your hand; that you, LORD, have done it. ²⁸They may curse, but you bless. When they arise, they will be shamed, but your servant shall rejoice. ²⁹Let my adversaries be clothed with dishonor. Let them cover themselves with their own shame as with a robe. ³⁰I will give great thanks to the LORD with my mouth. Yes, I will praise him among the multitude. ³¹For he will stand at the right hand of the needy, to save him from those who judge his soul.

110The LORD says to my Lord, "Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies your footstool for your feet." ²The LORD will send out the rod of your strength out of Zion. Rule among your enemies. ³Your people offer themselves willingly in the day of your power, in holy array. Out of the womb of the morning, you have the dew of your youth. ⁴The LORD has sworn, and will not change his mind: "You are a priest forever in the order of Melchizedek." ⁵The Lord is at your right hand. He will crush kings in the day of his wrath. ⁶He will judge among the nations. He will heap up dead bodies. He will crush the ruler of the whole earth. ⁷He will drink of the brook on the way; therefore he will lift up his head.

111Praise the LORD! ^{xxxix} I will give thanks to the LORD with my whole heart, in the council of the upright, and in the congregation. ²The LORD's works are great, pondered by all those who delight in them. ³His work is honor and majesty. His righteousness endures forever. ⁴He has caused his wonderful works to be remembered. The LORD is gracious and merciful. ⁵He has given food to those who fear him. He always remembers his covenant. ⁶He has shown his people the power of his works, in giving them the heritage of the nations. ⁷The works of his hands are truth and justice. All his precepts are sure. ⁸They

^{xxxviii}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{xxxix}Psalms 111 is an acrostic poem, with each verse after the initial "Praise the LORD!" starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav).

are established forever and ever. They are done in truth and uprightness. ⁹He has sent redemption to his people. He has ordained his covenant forever. His name is holy and awesome! ¹⁰The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom. All those who do his work have a good understanding. His praise endures forever!

112Praise the LORD! ^{x1} Blessed is the man who fears the LORD, who delights greatly in his commandments. ²His offspring will be mighty in the land. The generation of the upright will be blessed. ³Wealth and riches are in his house. His righteousness endures forever. ⁴Light dawns in the darkness for the upright, gracious, merciful, and righteous. ⁵It is well with the man who deals graciously and lends. He will maintain his cause in judgment. ⁶For he will never be shaken. The righteous will be remembered forever. ⁷He will not be afraid of evil news. His heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD. ⁸His heart is established. He will not be afraid in the end when he sees his adversaries. ⁹He has dispersed, he has given to the poor. His righteousness endures forever. His horn will be exalted with honor. ¹⁰The wicked will see it, and be grieved. He shall gnash with his teeth, and melt away. The desire of the wicked will perish.

113Praise the LORD! Praise, you servants of the LORD, praise the LORD's name. ²Blessed be the LORD's name, from this time forward and forever more. ³From the rising of the sun to its going down, The LORD's name is to be praised. ⁴The LORD is high above all nations, his glory above the heavens. ⁵Who is like the LORD, our God, who has his seat on high, ⁶who stoops down to see in heaven and in the earth? ⁷He raises up the poor out of the dust, and lifts up the needy from the ash heap, ⁸that he may set him with princes, even with the princes of his people. ⁹He settles the barren woman in her home as a joyful mother of children. Praise the LORD!

114When Israel went out of Egypt, the house of Jacob from a people of foreign language, ²Judah became his sanctuary, Israel his dominion. ³The sea saw it, and fled. The Jordan was driven back. ⁴The mountains skipped like rams, the little hills like lambs. ⁵What was it, you sea, that you fled? You Jordan, that you turned back? ⁶You mountains, that you skipped like rams? You little hills, like lambs? ⁷Tremble, you earth, at the presence of the Lord, at the presence of the God of Jacob, ⁸who turned the rock into a pool of water, the flint into a spring of waters.

115Not to us, LORD, not to us, but to your name

^{x1}Psalm 112 is an acrostic poem, with each verse after the initial "Praise the LORD!" starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav).

give glory, for your loving kindness, and for your truth's sake. ²Why should the nations say, "Where is their God, now?" ³But our God is in the heavens. He does whatever he pleases. ⁴Their idols are silver and gold, the work of men's hands. ⁵They have mouths, but they don't speak. They have eyes, but they don't see. ⁶They have ears, but they don't hear. They have noses, but they don't smell. ⁷They have hands, but they don't feel. They have feet, but they don't walk, neither do they speak through their throat. ⁸Those who make them will be like them; yes, everyone who trusts in them. ⁹Israel, trust in the LORD! He is their help and their shield. ¹⁰House of Aaron, trust in the LORD! He is their help and their shield. ¹¹You who fear the LORD, trust in the LORD! He is their help and their shield. ¹²The LORD remembers us. He will bless us. He will bless the house of Israel. He will bless the house of Aaron. ¹³He will bless those who fear the LORD, both small and great. ¹⁴May the LORD increase you more and more, you and your children. ¹⁵Blessed are you by the LORD, who made heaven and earth. ¹⁶The heavens are the LORD's heavens, but he has given the earth to the children of men. ¹⁷The dead don't praise the LORD, nor any who go down into silence, ¹⁸but we will bless the LORD, from this time forward and forever more. Praise the LORD!

116I love the LORD, because he listens to my voice, and my cries for mercy. ²Because he has turned his ear to me, therefore I will call on him as long as I live. ³The cords of death surrounded me, the pains of Sheol ^{xli} got a hold of me. I found trouble and sorrow. ⁴Then I called on the LORD's name: "LORD, I beg you, deliver my soul." ⁵The LORD is gracious and righteous. Yes, our God is merciful. ⁶The LORD preserves the simple. I was brought low, and he saved me. ⁷Return to your rest, my soul, for the LORD has dealt bountifully with you. ⁸For you have delivered my soul from death, my eyes from tears, and my feet from falling. ⁹I will walk before the LORD in the land of the living. ¹⁰I believed, therefore I said, "I was greatly afflicted." ¹¹I said in my haste, "All people are liars." ¹²What will I give to the LORD for all his benefits toward me? ¹³I will take the cup of salvation, and call on the LORD's name. ¹⁴I will pay my vows to the LORD, yes, in the presence of all his people. ¹⁵Precious in the LORD's sight is the death of his holy ones. ¹⁶LORD, truly I am your servant. I am your servant, the son of your servant girl. You have freed me from my chains. ¹⁷I will offer to you the sacrifice of thanksgiving, and will call on the LORD's name. ¹⁸I will pay my vows to the LORD, yes, in the presence of all his people, ¹⁹in the courts of the LORD's house, in the middle of you, Jerusalem. Praise the LORD!

^{xli}Sheol is the place of the dead.

117Praise the LORD, all you nations! Extol him, all you peoples! ²For his loving kindness is great toward us. The LORD's faithfulness endures forever. Praise the LORD!

118Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever. ²Let Israel now say that his loving kindness endures forever. ³Let the house of Aaron now say that his loving kindness endures forever. ⁴Now let those who fear the LORD say that his loving kindness endures forever. ⁵Out of my distress, I called on the LORD. The LORD answered me with freedom. ⁶The LORD is on my side. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me? ⁷The LORD is on my side among those who help me. Therefore I will look in triumph at those who hate me. ⁸It is better to take refuge in the LORD, than to put confidence in man. ⁹It is better to take refuge in the LORD, than to put confidence in princes. ¹⁰All the nations surrounded me, but in the LORD's name I cut them off. ¹¹They surrounded me, yes, they surrounded me. In the LORD's name I indeed cut them off. ¹²They surrounded me like bees. They are quenched like the burning thorns. In the LORD's name I cut them off. ¹³You pushed me back hard, to make me fall, but the LORD helped me. ¹⁴The LORD is my strength and song. He has become my salvation [yeshu'ah]. ¹⁵The voice of rejoicing and salvation [yeshu'ah] is in the tents of the righteous. "The right hand of the LORD does valiantly. ¹⁶The right hand of the LORD is exalted! The right hand of the LORD does valiantly!" ¹⁷I will not die, but live, and declare the LORD's works. ¹⁸The LORD has punished me severely, but he has not given me over to death. ¹⁹Open to me the gates of righteousness. I will enter into them. I will give thanks to the LORD. ²⁰This is the gate of the LORD; the righteous will enter into it. ²¹I will give thanks to you, for you have answered me, and have become my salvation [yeshu'ah]. ²²The stone which the builders rejected has become the cornerstone. ^{xlii} ²³This is the LORD's doing. It is marvelous in our eyes. ²⁴This is the day that the LORD has made. We will rejoice and be glad in it! ²⁵Save us now, we beg you, LORD! LORD, we beg you, send prosperity now. ²⁶Blessed is he who comes in the LORD's name! We have blessed you out of the LORD's house. ²⁷The LORD is God, and he has given us light. Bind the sacrifice with cords, even to the horns of the altar. ²⁸You are my God, and I will give thanks to you. You are my God, I will exalt you. ²⁹Oh give thanks to the LORD, for he is good, for his loving kindness endures forever.

119Blessed are those whose ways are blameless, who walk according to the LORD's law. ²Blessed are those who keep his statutes, who seek him with their whole heart.

³Yes, they do nothing wrong. They walk in his ways. ⁴You have commanded your precepts, that we should fully obey them. ⁵Oh that my ways were steadfast to obey your statutes! ⁶Then I wouldn't be disappointed, when I consider all of your commandments. ⁷I will give thanks to you with uprightness of heart, when I learn your righteous judgments. ⁸I will observe your statutes. Don't utterly forsake me. ⁹How can a young man keep his way pure? By living according to your word. ¹⁰With my whole heart I have sought you. Don't let me wander from your commandments. ¹¹I have hidden your word in my heart, that I might not sin against you. ¹²Blessed are you, LORD. Teach me your statutes. ¹³With my lips, I have declared all the ordinances of your mouth. ¹⁴I have rejoiced in the way of your testimonies, as much as in all riches. ¹⁵I will meditate on your precepts, and consider your ways. ¹⁶I will delight myself in your statutes. I will not forget your word. ¹⁷Do good to your servant. I will live and I will obey your word. ¹⁸Open my eyes, that I may see wondrous things out of your Torah. ¹⁹I am a stranger on the earth. Don't hide your commandments from me. ²⁰My soul is consumed with longing for your ordinances at all times. ²¹You have rebuked the proud who are cursed, who wander from your commandments. ²²Take reproach and contempt away from me, for I have kept your statutes. ²³Though princes sit and slander me, your servant will meditate on your statutes. ²⁴Indeed your statutes are my delight, and my counselors. ²⁵My soul is laid low in the dust. Revive me according to your word! ²⁶I declared my ways, and you answered me. Teach me your statutes. ²⁷Let me understand the teaching of your precepts! Then I will meditate on your wondrous works. ²⁸My soul is weary with sorrow; strengthen me according to your word. ²⁹Keep me from the way of deceit. Grant me your Torah graciously! ³⁰I have chosen the way of truth. I have set your ordinances before me. ³¹I cling to your statutes, LORD. Don't let me be disappointed. ³²I run in the path of your commandments, for you have set my heart free. ³³Teach me, LORD, the way of your statutes. I will keep them to the end. ³⁴Give me understanding, and I will keep your Torah. Yes, I will obey it with my whole heart. ³⁵Direct me in the path of your commandments, for I delight in them. ³⁶Turn my heart toward your statutes, not toward selfish gain. ³⁷Turn my eyes away from looking at worthless things. Revive me in your ways. ³⁸Fulfill your promise to your servant, that you may be feared. ³⁹Take away my disgrace that I dread, for your ordinances are good. ⁴⁰Behold, I long for your precepts! Revive me in your righteousness. ⁴¹Let your loving kindness also come to me, LORD, your salvation, according to your word. ⁴²So I will have an answer for him who reproaches me, for I trust in your word. ⁴³Don't snatch the word of truth out of my mouth, for I put my hope in your ordinances. ⁴⁴So I will obey your Torah continually, forever and ever. ⁴⁵I will walk in liberty, for I have sought

^{xlii}Literally,

your precepts. ⁴⁶I will also speak of your statutes before kings, and will not be disappointed. ⁴⁷I will delight myself in your commandments, because I love them. ⁴⁸I reach out my hands for your commandments, which I love. I will meditate on your statutes. ⁴⁹Remember your word to your servant, because you gave me hope. ⁵⁰This is my comfort in my affliction, for your word has revived me. ⁵¹The arrogant mock me excessively, but I don't swerve from your Torah. ⁵²I remember your ordinances of old, LORD, and have comforted myself. ⁵³Indignation has taken hold on me, because of the wicked who forsake your Torah. ⁵⁴Your statutes have been my songs in the house where I live. ⁵⁵I have remembered your name, LORD, in the night, and I obey your Torah. ⁵⁶This is my way, that I keep your precepts. ⁵⁷The LORD is my portion. I promised to obey your words. ⁵⁸I sought your favor with my whole heart. Be merciful to me according to your word. ⁵⁹I considered my ways, and turned my steps to your statutes. ⁶⁰I will hurry, and not delay, to obey your commandments. ⁶¹The ropes of the wicked bind me, but I won't forget your Torah. ⁶²At midnight I will rise to give thanks to you, because of your righteous ordinances. ⁶³I am a friend of all those who fear you, of those who observe your precepts. ⁶⁴The earth is full of your loving kindness, LORD. Teach me your statutes. ⁶⁵You have treated your servant well, according to your word, LORD. ⁶⁶Teach me good judgment and knowledge, for I believe in your commandments. ⁶⁷Before I was afflicted, I went astray; but now I observe your word. ⁶⁸You are good, and do good. Teach me your statutes. ⁶⁹The proud have smeared a lie upon me. With my whole heart, I will keep your precepts. ⁷⁰Their heart is as callous as the fat, but I delight in your Torah. ⁷¹It is good for me that I have been afflicted, that I may learn your statutes. ⁷²The Torah you have spoken is better to me than thousands of pieces of gold and silver. ⁷³Your hands have made me and formed me. Give me understanding, that I may learn your commandments. ⁷⁴Those who fear you will see me and be glad, because I have put my hope in your word. ⁷⁵LORD, I know that your judgments are righteous, that in faithfulness you have afflicted me. ⁷⁶Please let your loving kindness be for my comfort, according to your word to your servant. ⁷⁷Let your tender mercies come to me, that I may live; for your Torah is my delight. ⁷⁸Let the proud be disappointed, for they have overthrown me wrongfully. I will meditate on your precepts. ⁷⁹Let those who fear you turn to me. They will know your statutes. ⁸⁰Let my heart be blameless toward your decrees, that I may not be disappointed. ⁸¹My soul faints for your salvation. I hope in your word. ⁸²My eyes fail for your word. I say, "When will you comfort me?" ⁸³For I have become like a wineskin in the smoke. I don't forget your statutes. ⁸⁴How many are the days of your servant? When will you execute judgment on those who persecute me? ⁸⁵The proud have dug pits for me, contrary to your Torah. ⁸⁶All of your command-

ments are faithful. They persecute me wrongfully. Help me! ⁸⁷They had almost wiped me from the earth, but I didn't forsake your precepts. ⁸⁸Preserve my life according to your loving kindness, so I will obey the statutes of your mouth. ⁸⁹LORD, your word is settled in heaven forever. ⁹⁰Your faithfulness is to all generations. You have established the earth, and it remains. ⁹¹Your laws remain to this day, for all things serve you. ⁹²Unless your Torah had been my delight, I would have perished in my affliction. ⁹³I will never forget your precepts, for with them, you have revived me. ⁹⁴I am yours. Save me, for I have sought your precepts. ⁹⁵The wicked have waited for me, to destroy me. I will consider your statutes. ⁹⁶I have seen a limit to all perfection, but your commands are boundless. ⁹⁷How I love your Torah! It is my meditation all day. ⁹⁸Your commandments make me wiser than my enemies, for your commandments are always with me. ⁹⁹I have more understanding than all my teachers, for your testimonies are my meditation. ¹⁰⁰I understand more than the aged, because I have kept your precepts. ¹⁰¹I have kept my feet from every evil way, that I might observe your word. ¹⁰²I have not turned away from your ordinances, for you have taught me. ¹⁰³How sweet are your promises to my taste, more than honey to my mouth! ¹⁰⁴Through your precepts, I get understanding; therefore I hate every false way. ¹⁰⁵Your word is a lamp to my feet, and a light for my path. ¹⁰⁶I have sworn, and have confirmed it, that I will obey your righteous ordinances. ¹⁰⁷I am afflicted very much. Revive me, LORD, according to your word. ¹⁰⁸Accept, I beg you, the willing offerings of my mouth. LORD, teach me your ordinances. ¹⁰⁹My soul is continually in my hand, yet I won't forget your Torah. ¹¹⁰The wicked have laid a snare for me, yet I haven't gone astray from your precepts. ¹¹¹I have taken your testimonies as a heritage forever, for they are the joy of my heart. ¹¹²I have set my heart to perform your statutes forever, even to the end. ¹¹³I hate double-minded men, but I love your Torah. ¹¹⁴You are my hiding place and my shield. I hope in your word. ¹¹⁵Depart from me, you evildoers, that I may keep the commandments of my God. ¹¹⁶Uphold me according to your word, that I may live. Let me not be ashamed of my hope. ¹¹⁷Hold me up, and I will be safe, and will have respect for your statutes continually. ¹¹⁸You reject all those who stray from your statutes, for their deceit is in vain. ¹¹⁹You put away all the wicked of the earth like dross. Therefore I love your testimonies. ¹²⁰My flesh trembles for fear of you. I am afraid of your judgments. ¹²¹I have done what is just and righteous. Don't leave me to my oppressors. ¹²²Ensure your servant's well-being. Don't let the proud oppress me. ¹²³My eyes fail looking for your salvation, for your righteous word. ¹²⁴Deal with your servant according to your loving kindness. Teach me your statutes. ¹²⁵I am your servant. Give me understanding, that I may know your testimonies. ¹²⁶It is time to act, LORD, for they break

your Torah. ¹²⁷Therefore I love your commandments more than gold, yes, more than pure gold. ¹²⁸Therefore I consider all of your precepts to be right. I hate every false way. ¹²⁹Your testimonies are wonderful, therefore my soul keeps them. ¹³⁰The entrance of your words gives light. It gives understanding to the simple. ¹³¹I opened my mouth wide and panted, for I longed for your commandments. ¹³²Turn to me, and have mercy on me, as you always do to those who love your name. ¹³³Establish my footsteps in your word. Don't let any iniquity have dominion over me. ¹³⁴Redeem me from the oppression of man, so I will observe your precepts. ¹³⁵Make your face shine on your servant. Teach me your statutes. ¹³⁶Streams of tears run down my eyes, because they don't observe your Torah. ¹³⁷You are righteous, LORD. Your judgments are upright. ¹³⁸You have commanded your statutes in righteousness. They are fully trustworthy. ¹³⁹My zeal wears me out, because my enemies ignore your words. ¹⁴⁰Your promises have been thoroughly tested, and your servant loves them. ¹⁴¹I am small and despised. I don't forget your precepts. ¹⁴²Your righteousness is an everlasting righteousness. Your Torah is truth. ¹⁴³Trouble and anguish have taken hold of me. Your commandments are my delight. ¹⁴⁴Your testimonies are righteous forever. Give me understanding, that I may live. ¹⁴⁵I have called with my whole heart. Answer me, LORD! I will keep your statutes. ¹⁴⁶I have called to you. Save me! I will obey your statutes. ¹⁴⁷I rise before dawn and cry for help. I put my hope in your words. ¹⁴⁸My eyes stay open through the night watches, that I might meditate on your word. ¹⁴⁹Hear my voice according to your loving kindness. Revive me, LORD, according to your ordinances. ¹⁵⁰They draw near who follow after wickedness. They are far from your Torah. ¹⁵¹You are near, LORD. All your commandments are truth. ¹⁵²Of old I have known from your testimonies, that you have founded them forever. ¹⁵³Consider my affliction, and deliver me, for I don't forget your Torah. ¹⁵⁴Plead my cause, and redeem me! Revive me according to your promise. ¹⁵⁵Salvation is far from the wicked, for they don't seek your statutes. ¹⁵⁶Great are your tender mercies, LORD. Revive me according to your ordinances. ¹⁵⁷Many are my persecutors and my adversaries. I haven't swerved from your testimonies. ¹⁵⁸I look at the faithless with loathing, because they don't observe your word. ¹⁵⁹Consider how I love your precepts. Revive me, LORD, according to your loving kindness. ¹⁶⁰All of your words are truth. Every one of your righteous ordinances endures forever. ¹⁶¹Princes have persecuted me without a cause, but my heart stands in awe of your words. ¹⁶²I rejoice at your word, as one who finds great plunder. ¹⁶³I hate and abhor falsehood. I love your Torah. ¹⁶⁴Seven times a day, I praise you, because of your righteous ordinances. ¹⁶⁵Those who love your Torah have great peace. Nothing causes them to stumble. ¹⁶⁶I have hoped for your salvation, LORD. I have done your com-

mandments. ¹⁶⁷My soul has observed your testimonies. I love them exceedingly. ¹⁶⁸I have obeyed your precepts and your testimonies, for all my ways are before you. ¹⁶⁹Let my cry come before you, LORD. Give me understanding according to your word. ¹⁷⁰Let my supplication come before you. Deliver me according to your word. ¹⁷¹Let my lips utter praise, for you teach me your statutes. ¹⁷²Let my tongue sing of your word, for all your commandments are righteousness. ¹⁷³Let your hand be ready to help me, for I have chosen your precepts. ¹⁷⁴I have longed for your salvation [yeshuat], LORD. Your Torah is my delight. ¹⁷⁵Let my soul live, that I may praise you. Let your ordinances help me. ¹⁷⁶I have gone astray like a lost sheep. Seek your servant, for I don't forget your commandments.

120In my distress, I cried to the LORD. He answered me. ²Deliver my soul, LORD, from lying lips, from a deceitful tongue. ³What will be given to you, and what will be done more to you, you deceitful tongue? ⁴Sharp arrows of the mighty, with coals of juniper. ⁵Woe is me, that I live in Meshech, that I dwell among the tents of Kedar! ⁶My soul has had her dwelling too long with him who hates peace. ⁷I am for peace, but when I speak, they are for war.

121I will lift up my eyes to the hills. Where does my help come from? ²My help comes from the LORD, who made heaven and earth. ³He will not allow your foot to be moved. He who keeps you will not slumber. ⁴Behold, he who keeps Israel will neither slumber nor sleep. ⁵The LORD is your keeper. The LORD is your shade on your right hand. ⁶The sun will not harm you by day, nor the moon by night. ⁷The LORD will keep you from all evil. He will keep your soul. ⁸The LORD will keep your going out and your coming in, from this time forward, and forever more.

122I was glad when they said to me, "Let's go to the LORD's house!" ²Our feet are standing within your gates, Jerusalem! ³Jerusalem is built as a city that is compact together, ⁴where the tribes go up, even the LORD's tribes, according to an ordinance for Israel, to give thanks to the LORD's name. ⁵For there are set thrones for judgment, the thrones of David's house. ⁶Pray for the peace of Jerusalem. Those who love you will prosper. ⁷Peace be within your walls, and prosperity within your palaces. ⁸For my brothers' and companions' sakes, I will now say, "Peace be within you." ⁹For the sake of the house of the LORD our God, I will seek your good.

123I lift up my eyes to you, you who sit in the heavens. ²Behold, as the eyes of servants look to the hand of their master, as the eyes of a maid to the hand of her mistress, so our eyes look to the LORD, our God, until he has mercy

on us. ³Have mercy on us, LORD, have mercy on us, for we have endured much contempt. ⁴Our soul is exceedingly filled with the scoffing of those who are at ease, with the contempt of the proud.

124If it had not been the LORD who was on our side, let Israel now say, ²if it had not been the LORD who was on our side, when men rose up against us, ³then they would have swallowed us up alive, when their wrath was kindled against us, ⁴then the waters would have overwhelmed us, the stream would have gone over our soul. ⁵Then the proud waters would have gone over our soul. ⁶Blessed be the LORD, who has not given us as a prey to their teeth. ⁷Our soul has escaped like a bird out of the fowler's snare. The snare is broken, and we have escaped. ⁸Our help is in the LORD's name, who made heaven and earth.

125Those who trust in the LORD are as Mount Zion, which can't be moved, but remains forever. ²As the mountains surround Jerusalem, so the LORD surrounds his people from this time forward and forever more. ³For the scepter of wickedness won't remain over the allotment of the righteous, so that the righteous won't use their hands to do evil. ⁴Do good, LORD, to those who are good, to those who are upright in their hearts. ⁵But as for those who turn away to their crooked ways, The LORD will lead them away with the workers of iniquity. Peace be on Israel.

126When the LORD brought back those who returned to Zion, we were like those who dream. ²Then our mouth was filled with laughter, and our tongue with singing. Then they said among the nations, "The LORD has done great things for them." ³The LORD has done great things for us, and we are glad. ⁴Restore our fortunes again, LORD, like the streams in the Negev. ⁵Those who sow in tears will reap in joy. ⁶He who goes out weeping, carrying seed for sowing, will certainly come again with joy, carrying his sheaves.

127Unless the LORD builds the house, they who build it labor in vain. Unless the LORD watches over the city, the watchman guards it in vain. ²It is vain for you to rise up early, to stay up late, eating the bread of toil, for he gives sleep to his loved ones. ³Behold, children are a heritage of the LORD. The fruit of the womb is his reward. ⁴As arrows in the hand of a mighty man, so are the children of youth. ⁵Happy is the man who has his quiver full of them. They won't be disappointed when they speak with their enemies in the gate.

128Blessed is everyone who fears the LORD, who walks in his ways. ²For you will eat the labor of your hands. You will be happy, and it will be well with you. ³Your wife will be as a fruitful vine in the innermost parts of your house,

your children like olive shoots around your table. ⁴Behold, this is how the man who fears the LORD is blessed. ⁵May the LORD bless you out of Zion, and may you see the good of Jerusalem all the days of your life. ⁶Yes, may you see your children's children. Peace be upon Israel.

129Many times they have afflicted me from my youth up. Let Israel now say: ²many times they have afflicted me from my youth up, yet they have not prevailed against me. ³The plowers plowed on my back. They made their furrows long. ⁴The LORD is righteous. He has cut apart the cords of the wicked. ⁵Let them be disappointed and turned backward, all those who hate Zion. ⁶Let them be as the grass on the housetops, which withers before it grows up, ⁷with which the reaper doesn't fill his hand, nor he who binds sheaves, his bosom. ⁸Neither do those who go by say, "The blessing of the LORD be on you. We bless you in the LORD's name."

130Out of the depths I have cried to you, LORD. ²Lord, hear my voice. Let your ears be attentive to the voice of my petitions. ³If you, LORD, kept a record of sins, Lord, who could stand? ⁴But there is forgiveness with you, therefore you are feared. ⁵I wait for the LORD. My soul waits. I hope in his word. ⁶My soul longs for the Lord more than watchmen long for the morning, more than watchmen for the morning. ⁷Israel, hope in the LORD, for there is loving kindness with the LORD. Abundant redemption is with him. ⁸He will redeem Israel from all their sins.

131LORD, my heart isn't arrogant, nor my eyes lofty; nor do I concern myself with great matters, or things too wonderful for me. ²Surely I have stilled and quieted my soul, like a weaned child with his mother, like a weaned child is my soul within me. ³Israel, hope in the LORD, from this time forward and forever more.

132LORD, remember David and all his affliction, ²how he swore to the LORD, and vowed to the Mighty One of Jacob: ³"Surely I will not come into the structure of my house, nor go up into my bed; ⁴I will not give sleep to my eyes, or slumber to my eyelids, ⁵until I find out a place for the LORD, a dwelling for the Mighty One of Jacob." ⁶Behold, we heard of it in Ephrathah. We found it in the field of Jaar. ⁷"We will go into his dwelling place. We will worship at his footstool." ⁸Arise, LORD, into your resting place, you, and the ark of your strength. ⁹Let your priests be clothed with righteousness. Let your holy ones shout for joy! ¹⁰For your servant David's sake, don't turn away the face of your anointed one. ¹¹The LORD has sworn to David in truth. He will not turn from it: "I will set the fruit of your body on your throne. ¹²If your children will keep my covenant, my testimony that I will teach them, their children also will sit on your throne forever more."

¹³For the LORD has chosen Zion. He has desired it for his habitation. ¹⁴"This is my resting place forever. I will live here, for I have desired it. ¹⁵I will abundantly bless her provision. I will satisfy her poor with bread. ¹⁶I will also clothe her priests with salvation. Her holy ones will shout aloud for joy. ¹⁷I will make the horn of David to bud there. I have ordained a lamp for my anointed. ¹⁸I will clothe his enemies with shame, but on himself, his crown will shine."

133See how good and how pleasant it is for brothers to live together in unity! ²It is like the precious oil on the head, that ran down on the beard, even Aaron's beard, that came down on the edge of his robes, ³like the dew of Hermon, that comes down on the hills of Zion; for there the LORD gives the blessing, even life forever more.

134Look! Praise the LORD, all you servants of the LORD, who stand by night in the LORD's house! ²Lift up your hands in the sanctuary. Praise the LORD! ³May the LORD bless you from Zion, even he who made heaven and earth.

135Praise the LORD! Praise the LORD's name! Praise him, you servants of the LORD, ²you who stand in the LORD's house, in the courts of our God's house. ³Praise the LORD, for the LORD is good. Sing praises to his name, for that is pleasant. ⁴For the LORD has chosen Jacob for himself, Israel for his own possession. ⁵For I know that the LORD is great, that our Lord is above all gods. ⁶Whatever the LORD pleased, that he has done, in heaven and in earth, in the seas and in all deeps. ⁷He causes the clouds to rise from the ends of the earth. He makes lightnings with the rain. He brings the wind out of his treasures. ⁸He struck the firstborn of Egypt, both of man and animal. ⁹He sent signs and wonders into the middle of you, Egypt, on Pharaoh, and on all his servants. ¹⁰He struck many nations, and killed mighty kings— ¹¹Sihon king of the Amorites, Og king of Bashan, and all the kingdoms of Canaan— ¹²and gave their land for a heritage, a heritage to Israel, his people. ¹³Your name, LORD, endures forever; your renown, LORD, throughout all generations. ¹⁴For the LORD will judge his people and have compassion on his servants. ¹⁵The idols of the nations are silver and gold, the work of men's hands. ¹⁶They have mouths, but they can't speak. They have eyes, but they can't see. ¹⁷They have ears, but they can't hear, neither is there any breath in their mouths. ¹⁸Those who make them will be like them, yes, everyone who trusts in them. ¹⁹House of Israel, praise the LORD! House of Aaron, praise the LORD! ²⁰House of Levi, praise the LORD! You who fear the LORD, praise the LORD! ²¹Blessed be the LORD from Zion, who dwells in Jerusalem. Praise the LORD!

loving kindness endures forever. ²Give thanks to the God of gods, for his loving kindness endures forever. ³Give thanks to the Lord of lords, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁴to him who alone does great wonders, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁵to him who by understanding made the heavens, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁶to him who spread out the earth above the waters, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁷to him who made the great lights, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁸the sun to rule by day, for his loving kindness endures forever; ⁹the moon and stars to rule by night, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁰to him who struck down the Egyptian firstborn, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹¹and brought out Israel from among them, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹²with a strong hand, and with an outstretched arm, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹³to him who divided the Sea of Suf apart, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁴and made Israel to pass through the middle of it, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁵but overthrew Pharaoh and his army in the Sea of Suf, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁶to him who led his people through the wilderness, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁷to him who struck great kings, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁸and killed mighty kings, for his loving kindness endures forever; ¹⁹Sihon king of the Amorites, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²⁰Og king of Bashan, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²¹and gave their land as an inheritance, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²²even a heritage to Israel his servant, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²³who remembered us in our low estate, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²⁴and has delivered us from our adversaries, for his loving kindness endures forever; ²⁵who gives food to every creature, for his loving kindness endures forever. ²⁶Oh give thanks to the God of heaven, for his loving kindness endures forever.

137By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat down. Yes, we wept, when we remembered Zion. ²On the willows in that land, we hung up our harps. ³For there, those who led us captive asked us for songs. Those who tormented us demanded songs of joy: "Sing us one of the songs of Zion!" ⁴How can we sing the LORD's song in a foreign land? ⁵If I forget you, Jerusalem, let my right hand forget its skill. ⁶Let my tongue stick to the roof of my mouth if I don't remember you, if I don't prefer Jerusalem above my chief joy. ⁷Remember, LORD, against the children of Edom in the day of Jerusalem, who said, "Raze it! Raze it even to its foundation!" ⁸Daughter of Babylon, doomed to destruction, he will be happy who repays you, as you have done to us. ⁹Happy shall he be, who takes and dashes your little ones against the rock.

136Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good, for his

138I will give you thanks with my whole heart. Before

the gods, ^{xliii} I will sing praises to you. ²I will bow down toward your holy temple, and give thanks to your Name for your loving kindness and for your truth; for you have exalted your Name and your Word above all. ³In the day that I called, you answered me. You encouraged me with strength in my soul. ⁴All the kings of the earth will give you thanks, LORD, for they have heard the words of your mouth. ⁵Yes, they will sing of the ways of the LORD, for the LORD's glory is great! ⁶For though the LORD is high, yet he looks after the lowly; but he knows the proud from afar. ⁷Though I walk in the middle of trouble, you will revive me. You will stretch out your hand against the wrath of my enemies. Your right hand will save me. ⁸The LORD will fulfill that which concerns me. Your loving kindness, LORD, endures forever. Don't forsake the works of your own hands.

139 LORD, you have searched me, and you know me. ²You know my sitting down and my rising up. You perceive my thoughts from afar. ³You search out my path and my lying down, and are acquainted with all my ways. ⁴For there is not a word on my tongue, but behold, LORD, you know it altogether. ⁵You hem me in behind and before. You laid your hand on me. ⁶This knowledge is beyond me. It's lofty. I can't attain it. ⁷Where could I go from your Spirit? Or where could I flee from your presence? ⁸If I ascend up into heaven, you are there. If I make my bed in Sheol, ^{xliv} behold, you are there! ⁹If I take the wings of the dawn, and settle in the uttermost parts of the sea, ¹⁰even there your hand will lead me, and your right hand will hold me. ¹¹If I say, "Surely the darkness will overwhelm me. The light around me will be night," ¹²even the darkness doesn't hide from you, but the night shines as the day. The darkness is like light to you. ¹³For you formed my inmost being. You knit me together in my mother's womb. ¹⁴I will give thanks to you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Your works are wonderful. My soul knows that very well. ¹⁵My frame wasn't hidden from you, when I was made in secret, woven together in the depths of the earth. ¹⁶Your eyes saw my body. In your book they were all written, the days that were ordained for me, when as yet there were none of them. ¹⁷How precious to me are your thoughts, God! How vast is their sum! ¹⁸If I would count them, they are more in number than the sand. When I wake up, I am still with you. ¹⁹If only you, God, would kill the wicked. Get away from me, you bloodthirsty men! ²⁰For they speak against you wickedly. Your enemies take your name in vain. ²¹LORD, don't I hate those who hate you? Am I not grieved with those who rise up against you? ²²I hate them with perfect hatred. They have become my enemies. ²³Search me, God, and know my heart. Try me,

and know my thoughts. ²⁴See if there is any wicked way in me, and lead me in the everlasting way.

140 Deliver me, LORD, from evil men. Preserve me from violent men: ²those who devise mischief in their hearts. They continually gather themselves together for war. ³They have sharpened their tongues like a serpent. Viper's poison is under their lips. ⁴LORD, keep me from the hands of the wicked. Preserve me from the violent men who have determined to trip my feet. ⁵The proud have hidden a snare for me, they have spread the cords of a net by the path. They have set traps for me. ⁶I said to the LORD, "You are my God." Listen to the cry of my petitions, LORD. ⁷LORD, the Lord, the strength of my salvation, you have covered my head in the day of battle. ⁸LORD, don't grant the desires of the wicked. Don't let their evil plans succeed, or they will become proud. ⁹As for the head of those who surround me, let the mischief of their own lips cover them. ¹⁰Let burning coals fall on them. Let them be thrown into the fire, into miry pits, from where they never rise. ¹¹An evil speaker won't be established in the earth. Evil will hunt the violent man to overthrow him. ¹²I know that the LORD will maintain the cause of the afflicted, and justice for the needy. ¹³Surely the righteous will give thanks to your name. The upright will dwell in your presence.

141 LORD, I have called on you. Come to me quickly! Listen to my voice when I call to you. ²Let my prayer be set before you like incense; the lifting up of my hands like the evening sacrifice. ³Set a watch, LORD, before my mouth. Keep the door of my lips. ⁴Don't incline my heart to any evil thing, to practice deeds of wickedness with men who work iniquity. Don't let me eat of their delicacies. ⁵Let the righteous strike me, it is kindness; let him reprove me, it is like oil on the head; don't let my head refuse it; Yet my prayer is always against evil deeds. ⁶Their judges are thrown down by the sides of the rock. They will hear my words, for they are well spoken. ⁷"As when one plows and breaks up the earth, our bones are scattered at the mouth of Sheol." ^{xlv} ⁸For my eyes are on you, LORD, the Lord. I take refuge in you. Don't leave my soul destitute. ⁹Keep me from the snare which they have laid for me, from the traps of the workers of iniquity. ¹⁰Let the wicked fall together into their own nets while I pass by.

142 I cry with my voice to the LORD. With my voice, I ask the LORD for mercy. ²I pour out my complaint before him. I tell him my troubles. ³When my spirit was overwhelmed within me, you knew my route. On the path in which I walk, they have hidden a snare for me. ⁴Look

^{xliii}The word *elohim*, used here, usually means "God" but can also mean "gods", "princes", or "angels".

^{xliv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xlv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

on my right, and see; for there is no one who is concerned for me. Refuge has fled from me. No one cares for my soul. ⁵I cried to you, LORD. I said, "You are my refuge, my portion in the land of the living." ⁶Listen to my cry, for I am in desperate need. Deliver me from my persecutors, for they are too strong for me. ⁷Bring my soul out of prison, that I may give thanks to your name. The righteous will surround me, for you will be good to me.

143Hear my prayer, LORD. Listen to my petitions. In your faithfulness and righteousness, relieve me. ²Don't enter into judgment with your servant, for in your sight no man living is righteous. ³For the enemy pursues my soul. He has struck my life down to the ground. He has made me live in dark places, as those who have been long dead. ⁴Therefore my spirit is overwhelmed within me. My heart within me is desolate. ⁵I remember the days of old. I meditate on all your doings. I contemplate the work of your hands. ⁶I spread out my hands to you. My soul thirsts for you, like a parched land. Selah. ⁷Hurry to answer me, LORD. My spirit fails. Don't hide your face from me, so that I don't become like those who go down into the pit. ⁸Cause me to hear your loving kindness in the morning, for I trust in you. Cause me to know the way in which I should walk, for I lift up my soul to you. ⁹Deliver me, LORD, from my enemies. I flee to you to hide me. ¹⁰Teach me to do your will, for you are my God. Your Spirit is good. Lead me in the land of uprightness. ¹¹Revive me, LORD, for your name's sake. In your righteousness, bring my soul out of trouble. ¹²In your loving kindness, cut off my enemies, and destroy all those who afflict my soul, For I am your servant.

144Blessed be the LORD, my rock, who trains my hands to war, and my fingers to battle— ²my loving kindness, my fortress, my high tower, my deliverer, my shield, and he in whom I take refuge, who subdues my people under me. ³LORD, what is man, that you care for him? Or the son of man, that you think of him? ⁴Man is like a breath. His days are like a shadow that passes away. ⁵Part your heavens, LORD, and come down. Touch the mountains, and they will smoke. ⁶Throw out lightning, and scatter them. Send out your arrows, and rout them. ⁷Stretch out your hand from above, rescue me, and deliver me out of great waters, out of the hands of foreigners, ⁸whose mouths speak deceit, whose right hand is a right hand of falsehood. ⁹I will sing a new song to you, God. On a ten-stringed lyre, I will sing praises to you. ¹⁰You are he who gives salvation to kings, who rescues David, his servant, from the deadly sword. ¹¹Rescue me, and deliver me out of the hands of foreigners, whose mouths speak deceit, whose right hand is a right hand of falsehood. ¹²Then our sons will be like well-nurtured plants, our daughters like pillars carved to adorn a palace. ¹³Our barns are full, filled

with all kinds of provision. Our sheep produce thousands and ten thousands in our fields. ¹⁴Our oxen will pull heavy loads. There is no breaking in, and no going away, and no outcry in our streets. ¹⁵Happy are the people who are in such a situation. Happy are the people whose God is the LORD.

145^I will exalt you, my God, the King. I will praise your name forever and ever. ²Every day I will praise you. I will extol your name forever and ever. ³Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised! His greatness is unsearchable. ⁴One generation will commend your works to another, and will declare your mighty acts. ⁵I will meditate on the glorious majesty of your honor, on your wondrous works. ⁶Men will speak of the might of your awesome acts. I will declare your greatness. ⁷They will utter the memory of your great goodness, and will sing of your righteousness. ⁸The LORD is gracious, merciful, slow to anger, and of great loving kindness. ⁹The LORD is good to all. His tender mercies are over all his works. ¹⁰All your works will give thanks to you, LORD. Your holy ones will extol you. ¹¹They will speak of the glory of your kingdom, and talk about your power, ¹²to make known to the sons of men his mighty acts, the glory of the majesty of his kingdom. ¹³Your kingdom is an everlasting kingdom. Your dominion endures throughout all generations. The LORD is faithful in all his words, and loving in all his deeds. ^{xlvi} ¹⁴The LORD upholds all who fall, and raises up all those who are bowed down. ¹⁵The eyes of all wait for you. You give them their food in due season. ¹⁶You open your hand, and satisfy the desire of every living thing. ¹⁷The LORD is righteous in all his ways, and gracious in all his works. ¹⁸The LORD is near to all those who call on him, to all who call on him in truth. ¹⁹He will fulfill the desire of those who fear him. He also will hear their cry, and will save them. ²⁰The LORD preserves all those who love him, but he will destroy all the wicked. ²¹My mouth will speak the praise of the LORD. Let all flesh bless his holy name forever and ever.

146Praise the LORD! Praise the LORD, my soul. ²While I live, I will praise the LORD. I will sing praises to my God as long as I exist. ³Don't put your trust in princes, in a son of man in whom there is no help. ⁴His spirit departs, and he returns to the earth. In that very day, his thoughts perish. ⁵Happy is he who has the God of Jacob for his help, whose hope is in the LORD, his God, ⁶who made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them; who keeps truth forever; ⁷who executes justice for the oppressed; who gives food to the hungry. The LORD frees the prisoners. ⁸The LORD opens the eyes of the blind. The LORD raises up those who are bowed down. The LORD loves the righteous. ⁹The LORD preserves the foreigners. He upholds the fatherless and widow, but he turns the way of the wicked

^{xlvi}Some manuscripts omit these last two lines.

upside down. ¹⁰The LORD will reign forever; your God, O Zion, to all generations. Praise the LORD!

147 Praise the LORD, for it is good to sing praises to our God; for it is pleasant and fitting to praise him. ²The LORD builds up Jerusalem. He gathers together the outcasts of Israel. ³He heals the broken in heart, and binds up their wounds. ⁴He counts the number of the stars. He calls them all by their names. ⁵Great is our Lord, and mighty in power. His understanding is infinite. ⁶The LORD upholds the humble. He brings the wicked down to the ground. ⁷Sing to the LORD with thanksgiving. Sing praises on the harp to our God, ⁸who covers the sky with clouds, who prepares rain for the earth, who makes grass grow on the mountains. ⁹He provides food for the livestock, and for the young ravens when they call. ¹⁰He doesn't delight in the strength of the horse. He takes no pleasure in the legs of a man. ¹¹The LORD takes pleasure in those who fear him, in those who hope in his loving kindness. ¹²Praise the LORD, Jerusalem! Praise your God, Zion! ¹³For he has strengthened the bars of your gates. He has blessed your children within you. ¹⁴He makes peace in your borders. He fills you with the finest of the wheat. ¹⁵He sends out his commandment to the earth. His word runs very swiftly. ¹⁶He gives snow like wool, and scatters frost like ashes. ¹⁷He hurls down his hail like pebbles. Who can stand before his cold? ¹⁸He sends out his word, and melts them. He causes his wind to blow, and the waters flow. ¹⁹He shows his word to Jacob, his statutes and his ordinances to Israel. ²⁰He has not done this for just any nation. They don't know his ordinances. Praise the LORD!

148 Praise the LORD! Praise the LORD from the heavens! Praise him in the heights! ²Praise him, all his angels! Praise him, all his army! ³Praise him, sun and moon! Praise him, all you shining stars! ⁴Praise him, you heavens of heavens, you waters that are above the heavens. ⁵Let them praise the LORD's name, for he commanded, and they were created. ⁶He has also established them forever and ever. He has made a decree which will not pass away. ⁷Praise the LORD from the earth, you great sea creatures, and all depths, ⁸lightning and hail, snow and clouds, stormy wind, fulfilling his word, ⁹mountains and all hills, fruit trees and all cedars, ¹⁰wild animals and all livestock, small creatures and flying birds, ¹¹kings of the earth and all peoples, princes and all judges of the earth, ¹²both young men and maidens, old men and children. ¹³Let them praise the LORD's name, for his name alone is exalted. His glory is above the earth and the heavens. ¹⁴He has lifted up the horn of his people, the praise of all his holy ones, even of the children of Israel, a people near to him. Praise the LORD!

149 Praise the LORD! Sing to the LORD a new song,

his praise in the assembly of the holy ones. ²Let Israel rejoice in him who made them. Let the children of Zion be joyful in their King. ³Let them praise his name in the dance! Let them sing praises to him with tambourine and harp! ⁴For the LORD takes pleasure in his people. He crowns the humble with salvation [yeshu'ah]. ⁵Let the holy ones rejoice in honor. Let them sing for joy on their beds. ⁶May the high praises of God be in their mouths, and a two-edged sword in their hand, ⁷to execute vengeance on the nations, and punishments on the peoples; ⁸to bind their kings with chains, and their nobles with fetters of iron; ⁹to execute on them the written judgment. All his holy ones have this honor. Praise the LORD!

150 Praise the LORD! Praise God in his sanctuary! Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power! ²Praise him for his mighty acts! Praise him according to his excellent greatness! ³Praise him with the sounding of the shofar! Praise him with harp and lyre! ⁴Praise him with tambourine and dancing! Praise him with stringed instruments and flute! ⁵Praise him with loud cymbals! Praise him with resounding cymbals! ⁶Let everything that has breath praise the LORD! Praise the LORD!

Proverbs

¹The proverbs of Solomon, the son of David, king of Israel: ²to know wisdom and instruction; to discern the words of understanding; ³to receive instruction in wise dealing, in righteousness, justice, and equity; ⁴to give prudence to the simple, knowledge and discretion to the young man—⁵that the wise man may hear, and increase in learning; that the man of understanding may attain to sound counsel; ⁶to understand a proverb and parables, the words and riddles of the wise. ⁷The fear of the LORD ⁱ is the beginning of knowledge, but the foolish despise wisdom and instruction. ⁸My son, listen to your father's instruction, and don't forsake your mother's teaching; ⁹for they will be a garland to grace your head, and chains around your neck. ¹⁰My son, if sinners entice you, don't consent. ¹¹If they say, "Come with us. Let's lie in wait for blood. Let's lurk secretly for the innocent without cause. ¹²Let's swallow them up alive like Sheol, ⁱⁱ and whole, like those who go down into the pit. ¹³We'll find all valuable wealth. We'll fill our houses with plunder. ¹⁴You shall cast your lot among us. We'll all have one purse"—¹⁵my son, don't walk on the path with them. Keep your foot from their path, ¹⁶for their feet run to evil. They hurry to shed blood. ¹⁷For the net is spread in vain in the sight of any bird; ¹⁸but these lay in wait for their own blood. They lurk secretly for their own lives. ¹⁹So are the ways of everyone who is greedy for gain. It takes away the life of its owners. ²⁰Wisdom calls aloud in the street. She utters her voice in the public squares. ²¹She calls at the head of noisy places. At the entrance of the city gates, she utters her words: ²²"How long, you simple ones, will you love simplicity? How long will mockers delight themselves in mockery, and fools hate knowledge? ²³Turn at my reproof. Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I will pour out my spirit on you. I will make known my words to you. ²⁴Because I have called, and you have refused; I have stretched out my hand, and no one has paid attention; ²⁵but you have ignored all my counsel, and wanted none of my reproof; ²⁶I also will laugh at your disaster. I will mock when calamity overtakes you, ²⁷when calamity overtakes you like a storm,

when your disaster comes on like a whirlwind, when distress and anguish come on you. ²⁸Then they will call on me, but I will not answer. They will seek me diligently, but they will not find me, ²⁹because they hated knowledge, and didn't choose the fear of the LORD. ³⁰They wanted none of my counsel. They despised all my reproof. ³¹Therefore they will eat of the fruit of their own way, and be filled with their own schemes. ³²For the backsliding of the simple will kill them. The careless ease of fools will destroy them. ³³But whoever listens to me will dwell securely, and will be at ease, without fear of harm."

²My son, if you will receive my words, and store up my commandments within you, ²so as to turn your ear to wisdom, and apply your heart to understanding; ³yes, if you call out for discernment, and lift up your voice for understanding; ⁴if you seek her as silver, and search for her as for hidden treasures; ⁵then you will understand the fear of the LORD, and find the knowledge of God. ^{iv} ⁶For the LORD gives wisdom. Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding. ⁷He lays up sound wisdom for the upright. He is a shield to those who walk in integrity, ⁸that he may guard the paths of justice, and preserve the way of his holy ones. ⁹Then you will understand righteousness and justice, equity and every good path. ¹⁰For wisdom will enter into your heart. Knowledge will be pleasant to your soul. ¹¹Discretion will watch over you. Understanding will keep you, ¹²to deliver you from the way of evil, from the men who speak perverse things, ¹³who forsake the paths of uprightness, to walk in the ways of darkness, ¹⁴who rejoice to do evil, and delight in the perverseness of evil, ¹⁵who are crooked in their ways, and wayward in their paths, ¹⁶to deliver you from the strange woman, even from the foreigner who flatters with her words, ¹⁷who forsakes the friend of her youth, and forgets the covenant of her God; ¹⁸for her house leads down to death, her paths to the departed spirits. ¹⁹None who go to her return again, neither do they attain to the paths of life. ²⁰Therefore walk in the way of good men, and keep the paths of the righteous. ²¹For the upright will dwell in the land. The perfect will remain in it. ²²But the wicked will be cut off

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱSheol is the place of the dead.

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

from the land. The treacherous will be rooted out of it.

3My son, don't forget my teaching, but let your heart keep my commandments, ²for they will add to you length of days, years of life, and peace. ³Don't let kindness and truth forsake you. Bind them around your neck. Write them on the tablet of your heart. ⁴So you will find favor, and good understanding in the sight of God and man. ⁵Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and don't lean on your own understanding. ⁶In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight. ⁷Don't be wise in your own eyes. Fear the LORD, and depart from evil. ⁸It will be health to your body, and nourishment to your bones. ⁹Honor the LORD with your substance, with the first fruits of all your increase; ¹⁰so your barns will be filled with plenty, and your vats will overflow with new wine. ¹¹My son, don't despise the LORD's discipline, neither be weary of his correction; ¹²for whom the LORD loves, he corrects, even as a father reproves the son in whom he delights. ¹³Happy is the man who finds wisdom, the man who gets understanding. ¹⁴For her good profit is better than getting silver, and her return is better than fine gold. ¹⁵She is more precious than rubies. None of the things you can desire are to be compared to her. ¹⁶Length of days is in her right hand. In her left hand are riches and honor. ¹⁷Her ways are ways of pleasantness. All her paths are peace. ¹⁸She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her. Happy is everyone who retains her. ¹⁹By wisdom the LORD founded the earth. By understanding, he established the heavens. ²⁰By his knowledge, the depths were broken up, and the skies drop down the dew. ²¹My son, let them not depart from your eyes. Keep sound wisdom and discretion, ²²so they will be life to your soul, and grace for your neck. ²³Then you shall walk in your way securely. Your foot won't stumble. ²⁴When you lie down, you will not be afraid. Yes, you will lie down, and your sleep will be sweet. ²⁵Don't be afraid of sudden fear, neither of the desolation of the wicked, when it comes; ²⁶for the LORD will be your confidence, and will keep your foot from being taken. ²⁷Don't withhold good from those to whom it is due, when it is in the power of your hand to do it. ²⁸Don't say to your neighbor, "Go, and come again; tomorrow I will give it to you," when you have it by you. ²⁹Don't devise evil against your neighbor, since he dwells securely by you. ³⁰Don't strive with a man without cause, if he has done you no harm. ³¹Don't envy the man of violence. Choose none of his ways. ³²For the perverse is an abomination to the LORD, but his friendship is with the upright. ³³The LORD's curse is in the house of the wicked, but he blesses the habitation of the righteous. ³⁴Surely he mocks the mockers, but he gives grace to the humble. ³⁵The wise will inherit glory, but shame will be the promotion of fools.

4Listen, sons, to a father's instruction. Pay attention

and know understanding; ²for I give you sound learning. Don't forsake my law. ³For I was a son to my father, tender and an only child in the sight of my mother. ⁴He taught me, and said to me: "Let your heart retain my words. Keep my commandments, and live. ⁵Get wisdom. Get understanding. Don't forget, and don't deviate from the words of my mouth. ⁶Don't forsake her, and she will preserve you. Love her, and she will keep you. ⁷Wisdom is supreme. Get wisdom. Yes, though it costs all your possessions, get understanding. ⁸Esteem her, and she will exalt you. She will bring you to honor when you embrace her. ⁹She will give to your head a garland of grace. She will deliver a crown of splendor to you." ¹⁰Listen, my son, and receive my sayings. The years of your life will be many. ¹¹I have taught you in the way of wisdom. I have led you in straight paths. ¹²When you go, your steps will not be hampered. When you run, you will not stumble. ¹³Take firm hold of instruction. Don't let her go. Keep her, for she is your life. ¹⁴Don't enter into the path of the wicked. Don't walk in the way of evil men. ¹⁵Avoid it, and don't pass by it. Turn from it, and pass on. ¹⁶For they don't sleep unless they do evil. Their sleep is taken away, unless they make someone fall. ¹⁷For they eat the bread of wickedness and drink the wine of violence. ¹⁸But the path of the righteous is like the dawning light that shines more and more until the perfect day. ¹⁹The way of the wicked is like darkness. They don't know what they stumble over. ²⁰My son, attend to my words. Turn your ear to my sayings. ²¹Let them not depart from your eyes. Keep them in the center of your heart. ²²For they are life to those who find them, and health to their whole body. ²³Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it is the wellspring of life. ²⁴Put away from yourself a perverse mouth. Put corrupt lips far from you. ²⁵Let your eyes look straight ahead. Fix your gaze directly before you. ²⁶Make the path of your feet level. Let all of your ways be established. ²⁷Don't turn to the right hand nor to the left. Remove your foot from evil.

5My son, pay attention to my wisdom. Turn your ear to my understanding, ²that you may maintain discretion, that your lips may preserve knowledge. ³For the lips of an adulteress drip honey. Her mouth is smoother than oil, ⁴but in the end she is as bitter as wormwood, and as sharp as a two-edged sword. ⁵Her feet go down to death. Her steps lead straight to Sheol. ⁶She gives no thought to the way of life. Her ways are crooked, and she doesn't know it. ⁷Now therefore, my sons, listen to me. Don't depart from the words of my mouth. ⁸Remove your way far from her. Don't come near the door of her house, ⁹lest you give your honor to others, and your years to the cruel one; ¹⁰lest strangers feast on your wealth, and your labors enrich another man's house. ¹¹You will groan at your latter

^vSheol is the place of the dead.

end, when your flesh and your body are consumed,¹² and say, "How I have hated instruction, and my heart despised reproof.¹³ I haven't obeyed the voice of my teachers, nor turned my ear to those who instructed me!¹⁴ I have come to the brink of utter ruin, among the gathered assembly."¹⁵ Drink water out of your own cistern, running water out of your own well.¹⁶ Should your springs overflow in the streets, streams of water in the public squares?¹⁷ Let them be for yourself alone, not for strangers with you.¹⁸ Let your spring be blessed. Rejoice in the wife of your youth.¹⁹ A loving doe and a graceful deer— let her breasts satisfy you at all times. Be captivated always with her love.²⁰ For why should you, my son, be captivated with an adulteress? Why embrace the bosom of another?²¹ For the ways of man are before the LORD's eyes. He examines all his paths.²² The evil deeds of the wicked ensnare him. The cords of his sin hold him firmly.²³ He will die for lack of instruction. In the greatness of his folly, he will go astray.

6 My son, if you have become collateral for your neighbor, if you have struck your hands in pledge for a stranger,² you are trapped by the words of your mouth; you are ensnared with the words of your mouth.³ Do this now, my son, and deliver yourself, since you have come into the hand of your neighbor. Go, humble yourself. Press your plea with your neighbor.⁴ Give no sleep to your eyes, nor slumber to your eyelids.⁵ Free yourself, like a gazelle from the hand of the hunter, like a bird from the snare of the fowler.⁶ Go to the ant, you sluggard. Consider her ways, and be wise;⁷ which having no chief, overseer, or ruler,⁸ provides her bread in the summer, and gathers her food in the harvest.⁹ How long will you sleep, sluggard? When will you arise out of your sleep?¹⁰ A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep—¹¹ so your poverty will come as a robber, and your scarcity as an armed man.¹² A worthless person, a man of iniquity, is he who walks with a perverse mouth,¹³ who winks with his eyes, who signals with his feet, who motions with his fingers,¹⁴ in whose heart is perverseness, who devises evil continually, who always sows discord.¹⁵ Therefore his calamity will come suddenly. He will be broken suddenly, and that without remedy.¹⁶ There are six things which the LORD hates; yes, seven which are an abomination to him:¹⁷ arrogant eyes, a lying tongue, hands that shed innocent blood,¹⁸ a heart that devises wicked schemes, feet that are swift in running to mischief,¹⁹ a false witness who utters lies, and he who sows discord among brothers.²⁰ My son, keep your father's commandment, and don't forsake your mother's teaching.²¹ Bind them continually on your heart. Tie them around your neck.²² When you walk, it will lead you. When you sleep, it will watch over you. When you awake, it will talk with you.²³ For the commandment is a lamp, and the Torah is light. Reproofs of instruction are the way of life,²⁴ to keep you from the immoral woman,

from the flattery of the wayward wife's tongue.²⁵ Don't lust after her beauty in your heart, neither let her captivate you with her eyelids.²⁶ For a prostitute reduces you to a piece of bread. The adulteress hunts for your precious life.²⁷ Can a man scoop fire into his lap, and his clothes not be burned?²⁸ Or can one walk on hot coals, and his feet not be scorched?²⁹ So is he who goes in to his neighbor's wife. Whoever touches her will not be unpunished.³⁰ Men don't despise a thief if he steals to satisfy himself when he is hungry,³¹ but if he is found, he shall restore seven times. He shall give all the wealth of his house.³² He who commits adultery with a woman is void of understanding. He who does it destroys his own soul.³³ He will get wounds and dishonor. His reproach will not be wiped away.³⁴ For jealousy arouses the fury of the husband. He won't spare in the day of vengeance.³⁵ He won't regard any ransom, neither will he rest content, though you give many gifts.

7 My son, keep my words. Lay up my commandments within you.² Keep my commandments and live! Guard my teaching as the apple of your eye.³ Bind them on your fingers. Write them on the tablet of your heart.⁴ Tell wisdom, "You are my sister." Call understanding your relative,⁵ that they may keep you from the strange woman, from the foreigner who flatters with her words.⁶ For at the window of my house, I looked out through my lattice.⁷ I saw among the simple ones. I discerned among the youths a young man void of understanding,⁸ passing through the street near her corner, he went the way to her house,⁹ in the twilight, in the evening of the day, in the middle of the night and in the darkness.¹⁰ Behold, there a woman met him with the attire of a prostitute, and with crafty intent.¹¹ She is loud and defiant. Her feet don't stay in her house.¹² Now she is in the streets, now in the squares, and lurking at every corner.¹³ So she caught him, and kissed him. With an impudent face she said to him:¹⁴ "Sacrifices of peace offerings are with me. Today I have paid my vows.¹⁵ Therefore I came out to meet you, to diligently seek your face, and I have found you.¹⁶ I have spread my couch with carpets of tapestry, with striped cloths of the yarn of Egypt.¹⁷ I have perfumed my bed with myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon.¹⁸ Come, let's take our fill of loving until the morning. Let's solace ourselves with loving.¹⁹ For my husband isn't at home. He has gone on a long journey.²⁰ He has taken a bag of money with him. He will come home at the full moon."²¹ With persuasive words, she led him astray. With the flattering of her lips, she seduced him.²² He followed her immediately, as an ox goes to the slaughter, as a fool stepping into a noose.²³ Until an arrow strikes through his liver, as a bird hurries to the snare, and doesn't know that it will cost his life.²⁴ Now therefore, sons, listen to me. Pay attention to the words of my mouth.²⁵ Don't let your heart turn to her ways. Don't go astray in her paths,²⁶ for she has thrown down many

wounded. Yes, all her slain are a mighty army. ²⁷Her house is the way to Sheol, ^{vi} going down to the rooms of death.

⁸Doesn't wisdom cry out? Doesn't understanding raise her voice? ²On the top of high places by the way, where the paths meet, she stands. ³Beside the gates, at the entry of the city, at the entry doors, she cries aloud: ⁴"I call to you men! I send my voice to the sons of mankind. ⁵You simple, understand prudence! You fools, be of an understanding heart! ⁶Hear, for I will speak excellent things. The opening of my lips is for right things. ⁷For my mouth speaks truth. Wickedness is an abomination to my lips. ⁸All the words of my mouth are in righteousness. There is nothing crooked or perverse in them. ⁹They are all plain to him who understands, right to those who find knowledge. ¹⁰Receive my instruction rather than silver, knowledge rather than choice gold. ¹¹For wisdom is better than rubies. All the things that may be desired can't be compared to it. ¹²"I, wisdom, have made prudence my dwelling. Find out knowledge and discretion. ¹³The fear of the LORD is to hate evil. I hate pride, arrogance, the evil way, and the perverse mouth. ¹⁴Counsel and sound knowledge are mine. I have understanding and power. ¹⁵By me kings reign, and princes decree justice. ¹⁶By me princes rule, nobles, and all the righteous rulers of the earth. ¹⁷I love those who love me. Those who seek me diligently will find me. ¹⁸With me are riches, honor, enduring wealth, and prosperity. ¹⁹My fruit is better than gold, yes, than fine gold, my yield than choice silver. ²⁰I walk in the way of righteousness, in the middle of the paths of justice, ²¹that I may give wealth to those who love me. I fill their treasuries. ²²"The LORD possessed me in the beginning of his work, before his deeds of old. ²³I was set up from everlasting, from the beginning, before the earth existed. ²⁴When there were no depths, I was born, when there were no springs abounding with water. ²⁵Before the mountains were settled in place, before the hills, I was born; ²⁶while as yet he had not made the earth, nor the fields, nor the beginning of the dust of the world. ²⁷When he established the heavens, I was there. When he set a circle on the surface of the deep, ²⁸when he established the clouds above, when the springs of the deep became strong, ²⁹when he gave to the sea its boundary, that the waters should not violate his commandment, when he marked out the foundations of the earth, ³⁰then I was the craftsman by his side. I was a delight day by day, always rejoicing before him, ³¹rejoicing in his whole world. My delight was with the sons of men. ³²"Now therefore, my sons, listen to me, for blessed are those who keep my ways. ³³Hear instruction, and be wise. Don't refuse it. ³⁴Blessed is the man who hears me, watching daily at my gates, waiting at my door posts. ³⁵For whoever finds me finds life, and will obtain favor from the LORD. ³⁶But he

who sins against me wrongs his own soul. All those who hate me love death."

⁹Wisdom has built her house. She has carved out her seven pillars. ²She has prepared her meat. She has mixed her wine. She has also set her table. ³She has sent out her maidens. She cries from the highest places of the city: ⁴"Whoever is simple, let him turn in here!" As for him who is void of understanding, she says to him, ⁵"Come, eat some of my bread, Drink some of the wine which I have mixed! ⁶Leave your simple ways, and live. Walk in the way of understanding." ⁷One who corrects a mocker invites insult. One who reproves a wicked man invites abuse. ⁸Don't reprove a scoffer, lest he hate you. Reprove a wise person, and he will love you. ⁹Instruct a wise person, and he will be still wiser. Teach a righteous person, and he will increase in learning. ¹⁰The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom. The knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. ¹¹For by me your days will be multiplied. The years of your life will be increased. ¹²If you are wise, you are wise for yourself. If you mock, you alone will bear it. ¹³The foolish woman is loud, undisciplined, and knows nothing. ¹⁴She sits at the door of her house, on a seat in the high places of the city, ¹⁵to call to those who pass by, who go straight on their ways, ¹⁶"Whoever is simple, let him turn in here." As for him who is void of understanding, she says to him, ¹⁷"Stolen water is sweet. Food eaten in secret is pleasant." ¹⁸But he doesn't know that the departed spirits are there, that her guests are in the depths of Sheol. ^{vii}

¹⁰The proverbs of Solomon. A wise son makes a glad father; but a foolish son brings grief to his mother. ²Treasures of wickedness profit nothing, but righteousness delivers from death. ³The LORD will not allow the soul of the righteous to go hungry, but he thrusts away the desire of the wicked. ⁴He becomes poor who works with a lazy hand, but the hand of the diligent brings wealth. ⁵He who gathers in summer is a wise son, but he who sleeps during the harvest is a son who causes shame. ⁶Blessings are on the head of the righteous, but violence covers the mouth of the wicked. ⁷The memory of the righteous is blessed, but the name of the wicked will rot. ⁸The wise in heart accept commandments, but a chattering fool will fall. ⁹He who walks blamelessly walks surely, but he who perverts his ways will be found out. ¹⁰One who winks with the eye causes sorrow, but a chattering fool will fall. ¹¹The mouth of the righteous is a spring of life, but violence covers the mouth of the wicked. ¹²Hatred stirs up strife, but love covers all wrongs. ¹³Wisdom is found on the lips of him who has discernment, but a rod is for the back of him who is void of understanding. ¹⁴Wise men lay up knowledge, but the mouth of the foolish is near ruin. ¹⁵The rich man's

^{vi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{vii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

wealth is his strong city. The destruction of the poor is their poverty. ¹⁶The labor of the righteous leads to life. The increase of the wicked leads to sin. ¹⁷He is in the way of life who heeds correction, but he who forsakes reproof leads others astray. ¹⁸He who hides hatred has lying lips. He who utters a slander is a fool. ¹⁹In the multitude of words there is no lack of disobedience, but he who restrains his lips does wisely. ²⁰The tongue of the righteous is like choice silver. The heart of the wicked is of little worth. ²¹The lips of the righteous feed many, but the foolish die for lack of understanding. ²²The LORD's blessing brings wealth, and he adds no trouble to it. ²³It is a fool's pleasure to do wickedness, but wisdom is a man of understanding's pleasure. ²⁴What the wicked fear will overtake them, but the desire of the righteous will be granted. ²⁵When the whirlwind passes, the wicked is no more; but the righteous stand firm forever. ²⁶As vinegar to the teeth, and as smoke to the eyes, so is the sluggard to those who send him. ²⁷The fear of the LORD prolongs days, but the years of the wicked shall be shortened. ²⁸The prospect of the righteous is joy, but the hope of the wicked will perish. ²⁹The way of the LORD is a stronghold to the upright, but it is a destruction to the workers of iniquity. ³⁰The righteous will never be removed, but the wicked will not dwell in the land. ³¹The mouth of the righteous produces wisdom, but the perverse tongue will be cut off. ³²The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable, but the mouth of the wicked is perverse.

11 A false balance is an abomination to the LORD, but accurate weights are his delight. ²When pride comes, then comes shame, but with humility comes wisdom. ³The integrity of the upright shall guide them, but the perverseness of the treacherous shall destroy them. ⁴Riches don't profit in the day of wrath, but righteousness delivers from death. ⁵The righteousness of the blameless will direct his way, but the wicked shall fall by his own wickedness. ⁶The righteousness of the upright shall deliver them, but the unfaithful will be trapped by evil desires. ⁷When a wicked man dies, hope perishes, and expectation of power comes to nothing. ⁸A righteous person is delivered out of trouble, and the wicked takes his place. ⁹With his mouth the godless man destroys his neighbor, but the righteous will be delivered through knowledge. ¹⁰When it goes well with the righteous, the city rejoices. When the wicked perish, there is shouting. ¹¹By the blessing of the upright, the city is exalted, but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked. ¹²One who despises his neighbor is void of wisdom, but a man of understanding holds his peace. ¹³One who brings gossip betrays a confidence, but one who is of a trustworthy spirit is one who keeps a secret. ¹⁴Where there is no wise guidance, the nation falls, but in the multitude of counselors there is victory. ¹⁵He who is collateral for a stranger will suffer for it, but he who refuses pledges of col-

lateral is secure. ¹⁶A gracious woman obtains honor, but violent men obtain riches. ¹⁷The merciful man does good to his own soul, but he who is cruel troubles his own flesh. ¹⁸Wicked people earn deceitful wages, but one who sows righteousness reaps a sure reward. ¹⁹He who is truly righteous gets life. He who pursues evil gets death. ²⁰Those who are perverse in heart are an abomination to the LORD, but those whose ways are blameless are his delight. ²¹Most certainly, the evil man will not be unpunished, but the offspring ^{viii} of the righteous will be delivered. ²²Like a gold ring in a pig's snout, is a beautiful woman who lacks discretion. ²³The desire of the righteous is only good. The expectation of the wicked is wrath. ²⁴There is one who scatters, and increases yet more. There is one who withholds more than is appropriate, but gains poverty. ²⁵The liberal soul shall be made fat. He who waters shall be watered also himself. ²⁶People curse someone who withholds grain, but blessing will be on the head of him who sells it. ²⁷He who diligently seeks good seeks favor, but he who searches after evil, it shall come to him. ²⁸He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous shall flourish as the green leaf. ²⁹He who troubles his own house shall inherit the wind. The foolish shall be servant to the wise of heart. ³⁰The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life. He who is wise wins souls. ³¹Behold, the righteous shall be repaid in the earth, how much more the wicked and the sinner!

12 Whoever loves correction loves knowledge, but he who hates reproof is stupid. ²A good man shall obtain favor from the LORD, but he will condemn a man of wicked plans. ³A man shall not be established by wickedness, but the root of the righteous shall not be moved. ⁴A worthy woman is the crown of her husband, but a disgraceful wife is as rotteness in his bones. ⁵The thoughts of the righteous are just, but the advice of the wicked is deceitful. ⁶The words of the wicked are about lying in wait for blood, but the speech of the upright rescues them. ⁷The wicked are overthrown, and are no more, but the house of the righteous shall stand. ⁸A man shall be commended according to his wisdom, but he who has a warped mind shall be despised. ⁹Better is he who is little known, and has a servant, than he who honors himself and lacks bread. ¹⁰A righteous man respects the life of his animal, but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel. ¹¹He who tills his land shall have plenty of bread, but he who chases fantasies is void of understanding. ¹²The wicked desires the plunder of evil men, but the root of the righteous flourishes. ¹³An evil man is trapped by sinfulness of lips, but the righteous shall come out of trouble. ¹⁴A man shall be satisfied with good by the fruit of his mouth. The work of a man's hands shall be rewarded to him. ¹⁵The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but he who is wise listens to counsel. ¹⁶A fool shows his annoyance the same day, but

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one who overlooks an insult is prudent. ¹⁷He who is truthful testifies honestly, but a false witness lies. ¹⁸There is one who speaks rashly like the piercing of a sword, but the tongue of the wise heals. ¹⁹Truth's lips will be established forever, but a lying tongue is only momentary. ²⁰Deceit is in the heart of those who plot evil, but joy comes to the promoters of peace. ²¹No mischief shall happen to the righteous, but the wicked shall be filled with evil. ²²Lying lips are an abomination to the LORD, but those who do the truth are his delight. ²³A prudent man keeps his knowledge, but the hearts of fools proclaim foolishness. ²⁴The hands of the diligent ones shall rule, but laziness ends in slave labor. ²⁵Anxiety in a man's heart weighs it down, but a kind word makes it glad. ²⁶A righteous person is cautious in friendship, but the way of the wicked leads them astray. ²⁷The slothful man doesn't roast his game, but the possessions of diligent men are prized. ²⁸In the way of righteousness is life; in its path there is no death.

13A wise son listens to his father's instruction, but a scoffer doesn't listen to rebuke. ²By the fruit of his lips, a man enjoys good things, but the unfaithful crave violence. ³He who guards his mouth guards his soul. One who opens wide his lips comes to ruin. ⁴The soul of the sluggard desires, and has nothing, but the desire of the diligent shall be fully satisfied. ⁵A righteous man hates lies, but a wicked man brings shame and disgrace. ⁶Righteousness guards the way of integrity, but wickedness overthrows the sinner. ⁷There are some who pretend to be rich, yet have nothing. There are some who pretend to be poor, yet have great wealth. ⁸The ransom of a man's life is his riches, but the poor hear no threats. ⁹The light of the righteous shines brightly, but the lamp of the wicked is snuffed out. ¹⁰Pride only breeds quarrels, but wisdom is with people who take advice. ¹¹Wealth gained dishonestly dwindles away, but he who gathers by hand makes it grow. ¹²Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but when longing is fulfilled, it is a tree of life. ¹³Whoever despises instruction will pay for it, but he who respects a command will be rewarded. ¹⁴The teaching of the wise is a spring of life, to turn from the snares of death. ¹⁵Good understanding wins favor, but the way of the unfaithful is hard. ¹⁶Every prudent man acts from knowledge, but a fool exposes folly. ¹⁷A wicked messenger falls into trouble, but a trustworthy envoy gains healing. ¹⁸Poverty and shame come to him who refuses discipline, but he who heeds correction shall be honored. ¹⁹Longing fulfilled is sweet to the soul, but fools detest turning from evil. ²⁰One who walks with wise men grows wise, but a companion of fools suffers harm. ²¹Misfortune pursues sinners, but prosperity rewards the righteous. ²²A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children, but the wealth of the sinner is stored for the righteous. ²³An abundance of food is in poor people's fields, but injustice sweeps it away. ²⁴One who spares the rod hates

his son, but one who loves him is careful to discipline him. ²⁵The righteous one eats to the satisfying of his soul, but the belly of the wicked goes hungry.

14Every wise woman builds her house, but the foolish one tears it down with her own hands. ²He who walks in his uprightness fears the LORD, but he who is perverse in his ways despises him. ³The fool's talk brings a rod to his back, but the lips of the wise protect them. ⁴Where no oxen are, the crib is clean, but much increase is by the strength of the ox. ⁵A truthful witness will not lie, but a false witness pours out lies. ⁶A scoffer seeks wisdom, and doesn't find it, but knowledge comes easily to a discerning person. ⁷Stay away from a foolish man, for you won't find knowledge on his lips. ⁸The wisdom of the prudent is to think about his way, but the folly of fools is deceit. ⁹Fools mock at making atonement for sins, but among the upright there is good will. ¹⁰The heart knows its own bitterness and joy; he will not share these with a stranger. ¹¹The house of the wicked will be overthrown, but the tent of the upright will flourish. ¹²There is a way which seems right to a man, but in the end it leads to death. ¹³Even in laughter the heart may be sorrowful, and mirth may end in heaviness. ¹⁴The unfaithful will be repaid for his own ways; likewise a good man will be rewarded for his ways. ¹⁵A simple man believes everything, but the prudent man carefully considers his ways. ¹⁶A wise man fears and shuns evil, but the fool is hot headed and reckless. ¹⁷He who is quick to become angry will commit folly, and a crafty man is hated. ¹⁸The simple inherit folly, but the prudent are crowned with knowledge. ¹⁹The evil bow down before the good, and the wicked at the gates of the righteous. ²⁰The poor person is shunned even by his own neighbor, but the rich person has many friends. ²¹He who despises his neighbor sins, but he who has pity on the poor is blessed. ²²Don't they go astray who plot evil? But love and faithfulness belong to those who plan good. ²³In all hard work there is profit, but the talk of the lips leads only to poverty. ²⁴The crown of the wise is their riches, but the folly of fools crowns them with folly. ²⁵A truthful witness saves souls, but a false witness is deceitful. ²⁶In the fear of the LORD is a secure fortress, and he will be a refuge for his children. ²⁷The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, turning people from the snares of death. ²⁸In the multitude of people is the king's glory, but in the lack of people is the destruction of the prince. ²⁹He who is slow to anger has great understanding, but he who has a quick temper displays folly. ³⁰The life of the body is a heart at peace, but envy rots the bones. ³¹He who oppresses the poor shows contempt for his Maker, but he who is kind to the needy honors him. ³²The wicked is brought down in his calamity, but in death, the righteous has a refuge. ³³Wisdom rests in the heart of one who has understanding, and is even made known in the inward part of fools.

³⁴Righteousness exalts a nation, but sin is a disgrace to any people. ³⁵The king's favor is toward a servant who deals wisely, but his wrath is toward one who causes shame.

15A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger. ²The tongue of the wise commends knowledge, but the mouths of fools gush out folly. ³The LORD's eyes are everywhere, keeping watch on the evil and the good. ⁴A gentle tongue is a tree of life, but deceit in it crushes the spirit. ⁵A fool despises his father's correction, but he who heeds reproof shows prudence. ⁶In the house of the righteous is much treasure, but the income of the wicked brings trouble. ⁷The lips of the wise spread knowledge; not so with the heart of fools. ⁸The sacrifice made by the wicked is an abomination to the LORD, but the prayer of the upright is his delight. ⁹The way of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD, but he loves him who follows after righteousness. ¹⁰There is stern discipline for one who forsakes the way. Whoever hates reproof shall die. ¹¹Sheol ^{ix} and Abaddon are before the LORD— how much more than the hearts of the children of men! ¹²A scoffer doesn't love to be reproved; he will not go to the wise. ¹³A glad heart makes a cheerful face, but an aching heart breaks the spirit. ¹⁴The heart of one who has understanding seeks knowledge, but the mouths of fools feed on folly. ¹⁵All the days of the afflicted are wretched, but one who has a cheerful heart enjoys a continual feast. ¹⁶Better is little, with the fear of the LORD, than great treasure with trouble. ¹⁷Better is a dinner of herbs, where love is, than a fattened calf with hatred. ¹⁸A wrathful man stirs up contention, but one who is slow to anger appeases strife. ¹⁹The way of the sluggard is like a thorn patch, but the path of the upright is a highway. ²⁰A wise son makes a father glad, but a foolish man despises his mother. ²¹Folly is joy to one who is void of wisdom, but a man of understanding keeps his way straight. ²²Where there is no counsel, plans fail; but in a multitude of counselors they are established. ²³Joy comes to a man with the reply of his mouth. How good is a word at the right time! ²⁴The path of life leads upward for the wise, to keep him from going downward to Sheol. ^x ²⁵The LORD will uproot the house of the proud, but he will keep the widow's borders intact. ²⁶The LORD detests the thoughts of the wicked, but the thoughts of the pure are pleasing. ²⁷He who is greedy for gain troubles his own house, but he who hates bribes will live. ²⁸The heart of the righteous weighs answers, but the mouth of the wicked gushes out evil. ²⁹The LORD is far from the wicked, but he hears the prayer of the righteous. ³⁰The light of the eyes rejoices the heart. Good news gives health to the bones. ³¹The ear that listens to reproof lives, and will be at home among the wise. ³²He who refuses correction despises his own soul, but he who listens to re-

proof gets understanding. ³³The fear of the LORD teaches wisdom. Before honor is humility.

16The plans of the heart belong to man, but the answer of the tongue is from the LORD. ²All the ways of a man are clean in his own eyes, but the LORD weighs the motives. ³Commit your deeds to the LORD, and your plans shall succeed. ⁴The LORD has made everything for its own end— yes, even the wicked for the day of evil. ⁵Everyone who is proud in heart is an abomination to the LORD; they shall certainly not be unpunished. ⁶By mercy and truth iniquity is atoned for. By the fear of the LORD men depart from evil. ⁷When a man's ways please the LORD, he makes even his enemies to be at peace with him. ⁸Better is a little with righteousness, than great revenues with injustice. ⁹A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD directs his steps. ¹⁰Inspired judgments are on the lips of the king. He shall not betray his mouth. ¹¹Honest balances and scales are the LORD's; all the weights in the bag are his work. ¹²It is an abomination for kings to do wrong, for the throne is established by righteousness. ¹³Righteous lips are the delight of kings. They value one who speaks the truth. ¹⁴The king's wrath is a messenger of death, but a wise man will pacify it. ¹⁵In the light of the king's face is life. His favor is like a cloud of the spring rain. ¹⁶How much better it is to get wisdom than gold! Yes, to get understanding is to be chosen rather than silver. ¹⁷The highway of the upright is to depart from evil. He who keeps his way preserves his soul. ¹⁸Pride goes before destruction, and an arrogant spirit before a fall. ¹⁹It is better to be of a lowly spirit with the poor, than to divide the plunder with the proud. ²⁰He who heeds the Word finds prosperity. Whoever trusts in the LORD is blessed. ²¹The wise in heart shall be called prudent. Pleasantness of the lips promotes instruction. ²²Understanding is a fountain of life to one who has it, but the punishment of fools is their folly. ²³The heart of the wise instructs his mouth, and adds learning to his lips. ²⁴Pleasant words are a honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones. ²⁵There is a way which seems right to a man, but in the end it leads to death. ²⁶The appetite of the laboring man labors for him, for his mouth urges him on. ²⁷A worthless man devises mischief. His speech is like a scorching fire. ²⁸A perverse man stirs up strife. A whisperer separates close friends. ²⁹A man of violence entices his neighbor, and leads him in a way that is not good. ³⁰One who winks his eyes to plot perversities, one who compresses his lips, is bent on evil. ³¹Gray hair is a crown of glory. It is attained by a life of righteousness. ³²One who is slow to anger is better than the mighty; one who rules his spirit, than he who takes a city. ³³The lot is cast into the lap, but its every decision is from the LORD.

17Better is a dry morsel with quietness, than a house

^{ix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^xSheol is the place of the dead.

full of feasting with strife. ²A servant who deals wisely will rule over a son who causes shame, and shall have a part in the inheritance among the brothers. ³The refining pot is for silver, and the furnace for gold, but the LORD tests the hearts. ⁴An evildoer heeds wicked lips. A liar gives ear to a mischievous tongue. ⁵Whoever mocks the poor reproaches his Maker. He who is glad at calamity shall not be unpunished. ⁶Children's children are the crown of old men; the glory of children is their parents. ⁷Excellent speech isn't fitting for a fool, much less do lying lips fit a prince. ⁸A bribe is a precious stone in the eyes of him who gives it; wherever he turns, he prospers. ⁹He who covers an offense promotes love; but he who repeats a matter separates best friends. ¹⁰A rebuke enters deeper into one who has understanding than a hundred lashes into a fool. ¹¹An evil man seeks only rebellion; therefore a cruel messenger shall be sent against him. ¹²Let a bear robbed of her cubs meet a man, rather than a fool in his folly. ¹³Whoever rewards evil for good, evil shall not depart from his house. ¹⁴The beginning of strife is like breaching a dam, therefore stop contention before quarreling breaks out. ¹⁵He who justifies the wicked, and he who condemns the righteous, both of them alike are an abomination to the LORD. ¹⁶Why is there money in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, since he has no understanding? ¹⁷A friend loves at all times; and a brother is born for adversity. ¹⁸A man void of understanding strikes hands, and becomes collateral in the presence of his neighbor. ¹⁹He who loves disobedience loves strife. One who builds a high gate seeks destruction. ²⁰One who has a perverse heart doesn't find prosperity, and one who has a deceitful tongue falls into trouble. ²¹He who becomes the father of a fool grieves. The father of a fool has no joy. ²²A cheerful heart makes good medicine, but a crushed spirit dries up the bones. ²³A wicked man receives a bribe in secret, to pervert the ways of justice. ²⁴Wisdom is before the face of one who has understanding, but the eyes of a fool wander to the ends of the earth. ²⁵A foolish son brings grief to his father, and bitterness to her who bore him. ²⁶Also to punish the righteous is not good, nor to flog officials for their integrity. ²⁷He who spares his words has knowledge. He who is even tempered is a man of understanding. ²⁸Even a fool, when he keeps silent, is counted wise. When he shuts his lips, he is thought to be discerning.

18A man who isolates himself pursues selfishness, and defies all sound judgment. ²A fool has no delight in understanding, but only in revealing his own opinion. ³When wickedness comes, contempt also comes, and with shame comes disgrace. ⁴The words of a man's mouth are like deep waters. The fountain of wisdom is like a flowing brook. ⁵To be partial to the faces of the wicked is not good, nor to deprive the innocent of justice. ⁶A fool's lips come into strife, and his mouth invites beatings. ⁷A fool's

mouth is his destruction, and his lips are a snare to his soul. ⁸The words of a gossip are like dainty morsels: they go down into a person's innermost parts. ⁹One who is slack in his work is brother to him who is a master of destruction. ¹⁰The LORD's name is a strong tower: the righteous run to him, and are safe. ¹¹The rich man's wealth is his strong city, like an unscalable wall in his own imagination. ¹²Before destruction the heart of man is proud, but before honor is humility. ¹³He who answers before he hears, that is folly and shame to him. ¹⁴A man's spirit will sustain him in sickness, but a crushed spirit, who can bear? ¹⁵The heart of the discerning gets knowledge. The ear of the wise seeks knowledge. ¹⁶A man's gift makes room for him, and brings him before great men. ¹⁷He who pleads his cause first seems right—until another comes and questions him. ¹⁸The lot settles disputes, and keeps strong ones apart. ¹⁹A brother offended is more difficult than a fortified city. Disputes are like the bars of a fortress. ²⁰A man's stomach is filled with the fruit of his mouth. With the harvest of his lips he is satisfied. ²¹Death and life are in the power of the tongue; those who love it will eat its fruit. ²²Whoever finds a wife finds a good thing, and obtains favor of the LORD. ²³The poor plead for mercy, but the rich answer harshly. ²⁴A man of many companions may be ruined, but there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother.

19Better is the poor who walks in his integrity than he who is perverse in his lips and is a fool. ²It isn't good to have zeal without knowledge, nor being hasty with one's feet and missing the way. ³The foolishness of man subverts his way; his heart rages against the LORD. ⁴Wealth adds many friends, but the poor is separated from his friend. ⁵A false witness shall not be unpunished. He who pours out lies shall not go free. ⁶Many will entreat the favor of a ruler, and everyone is a friend to a man who gives gifts. ⁷All the relatives of the poor shun him; how much more do his friends avoid him! He pursues them with pleas, but they are gone. ⁸He who gets wisdom loves his own soul. He who keeps understanding shall find good. ⁹A false witness shall not be unpunished. He who utters lies shall perish. ¹⁰Delicate living is not appropriate for a fool, much less for a servant to have rule over princes. ¹¹The discretion of a man makes him slow to anger. It is his glory to overlook an offense. ¹²The king's wrath is like the roaring of a lion, but his favor is like dew on the grass. ¹³A foolish son is the calamity of his father. A wife's quarrels are a continual dripping. ¹⁴House and riches are an inheritance from fathers, but a prudent wife is from the LORD. ¹⁵Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep. The idle soul shall suffer hunger. ¹⁶He who keeps the commandment keeps his soul, but he who is contemptuous in his ways shall die. ¹⁷He who has pity on the poor lends to the LORD; he will reward him. ¹⁸Discipline your son, for there is hope; don't be a will-ind party to his death. ¹⁹A hot-tempered man must pay

the penalty, for if you rescue him, you must do it again. ²⁰Listen to counsel and receive instruction, that you may be wise in your latter end. ²¹There are many plans in a man's heart, but the LORD's counsel will prevail. ²²That which makes a man to be desired is his kindness. A poor man is better than a liar. ²³The fear of the LORD leads to life, then contentment; he rests and will not be touched by trouble. ²⁴The sluggard buries his hand in the dish; he will not so much as bring it to his mouth again. ²⁵Flog a scoffer, and the simple will learn prudence; rebuke one who has understanding, and he will gain knowledge. ²⁶He who robs his father and drives away his mother is a son who causes shame and brings reproach. ²⁷If you stop listening to instruction, my son, you will stray from the words of knowledge. ²⁸A corrupt witness mocks justice, and the mouth of the wicked gulps down iniquity. ²⁹Penalties are prepared for scoffers, and beatings for the backs of fools.

²⁰Wine is a mocker and beer is a brawler. Whoever is led astray by them is not wise. ²The terror of a king is like the roaring of a lion. He who provokes him to anger forfeits his own life. ³It is an honor for a man to keep aloof from strife, but every fool will be quarreling. ⁴The sluggard will not plow by reason of the winter; therefore he shall beg in harvest, and have nothing. ⁵Counsel in the heart of man is like deep water, but a man of understanding will draw it out. ⁶Many men claim to be men of unfailing love, but who can find a faithful man? ⁷A righteous man walks in integrity. Blessed are his children after him. ⁸A king who sits on the throne of judgment scatters away all evil with his eyes. ⁹Who can say, "I have made my heart pure. I am clean and without sin?" ¹⁰Differing weights and differing measures, both of them alike are an abomination to the LORD. ¹¹Even a child makes himself known by his doings, whether his work is pure, and whether it is right. ¹²The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, The LORD has made even both of them. ¹³Don't love sleep, lest you come to poverty. Open your eyes, and you shall be satisfied with bread. ¹⁴"It's no good, it's no good," says the buyer; but when he is gone his way, then he boasts. ¹⁵There is gold and abundance of rubies, but the lips of knowledge are a rare jewel. ¹⁶Take the garment of one who puts up collateral for a stranger; and hold him in pledge for a wayward woman. ¹⁷Fraudulent food is sweet to a man, but afterwards his mouth is filled with gravel. ¹⁸Plans are established by advice; by wise guidance you wage war! ¹⁹He who goes about as a tale-bearer reveals secrets; therefore don't keep company with him who opens wide his lips. ²⁰Whoever curses his father or his mother, his lamp shall be put out in blackness of darkness. ²¹An inheritance quickly gained at the beginning won't be blessed in the end. ²²Don't say, "I will pay back evil." Wait for the LORD, and he will save you. ²³The LORD detests differing weights, and dishonest scales are not pleasing. ²⁴A

man's steps are from the LORD; how then can man understand his way? ²⁵It is a snare to a man to make a rash dedication, then later to consider his vows. ²⁶A wise king winnows out the wicked, and drives the threshing wheel over them. ²⁷The spirit of man is the LORD's lamp, searching all his innermost parts. ²⁸Love and faithfulness keep the king safe. His throne is sustained by love. ²⁹The glory of young men is their strength. The splendor of old men is their gray hair. ³⁰Wounding blows cleanse away evil, and beatings purge the innermost parts.

²¹The king's heart is in the LORD's hand like the watercourses. He turns it wherever he desires. ²Every way of a man is right in his own eyes, but the LORD weighs the hearts. ³To do righteousness and justice is more acceptable to the LORD than sacrifice. ⁴A high look and a proud heart, the lamp of the wicked, is sin. ⁵The plans of the diligent surely lead to profit; and everyone who is hasty surely rushes to poverty. ⁶Getting treasures by a lying tongue is a fleeting vapor for those who seek death. ⁷The violence of the wicked will drive them away, because they refuse to do what is right. ⁸The way of the guilty is devious, but the conduct of the innocent is upright. ⁹It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop than to share a house with a contentious woman. ¹⁰The soul of the wicked desires evil; his neighbor finds no mercy in his eyes. ¹¹When the mocker is punished, the simple gains wisdom. When the wise is instructed, he receives knowledge. ¹²The Righteous One considers the house of the wicked, and brings the wicked to ruin. ¹³Whoever stops his ears at the cry of the poor, he will also cry out, but shall not be heard. ¹⁴A gift in secret pacifies anger, and a bribe in the cloak, strong wrath. ¹⁵It is joy to the righteous to do justice; but it is a destruction to the workers of iniquity. ¹⁶The man who wanders out of the way of understanding shall rest in the assembly of the departed spirits. ¹⁷He who loves pleasure will be a poor man. He who loves wine and oil won't be rich. ¹⁸The wicked is a ransom for the righteous, the treacherous for the upright. ¹⁹It is better to dwell in a desert land, than with a contentious and fretful woman. ²⁰There is precious treasure and oil in the dwelling of the wise, but a foolish man swallows it up. ²¹He who follows after righteousness and kindness finds life, righteousness, and honor. ²²A wise man scales the city of the mighty, and brings down the strength of its confidence. ²³Whoever guards his mouth and his tongue keeps his soul from troubles. ²⁴The proud and arrogant man—"Scoffer" is his name—he works in the arrogance of pride. ²⁵The desire of the sluggard kills him, for his hands refuse to labor. ²⁶There are those who covet greedily all day long; but the righteous give and don't withhold. ²⁷The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination—how much more, when he brings it with a wicked mind! ²⁸A false witness will perish. A man who listens speaks to eternity. ²⁹A wicked man

hardens his face; but as for the upright, he establishes his ways. ³⁰There is no wisdom nor understanding nor counsel against the LORD. ³¹The horse is prepared for the day of battle; but victory is with the LORD.

22A good name is more desirable than great riches, and loving favor is better than silver and gold. ²The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is the maker of them all. ³A prudent man sees danger and hides himself; but the simple pass on, and suffer for it. ⁴The result of humility and the fear of the LORD is wealth, honor, and life. ⁵Thorns and snares are in the path of the wicked; whoever guards his soul stays from them. ⁶Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it. ⁷The rich rule over the poor. The borrower is servant to the lender. ⁸He who sows wickedness reaps trouble, and the rod of his fury will be destroyed. ⁹He who has a generous eye will be blessed, for he shares his food with the poor. ¹⁰Drive out the mocker, and strife will go out; yes, quarrels and insults will stop. ¹¹He who loves purity of heart and speaks gracefully is the king's friend. ¹²The LORD's eyes watch over knowledge, but he frustrates the words of the unfaithful. ¹³The sluggard says, "There is a lion outside! I will be killed in the streets!" ¹⁴The mouth of an adulteress is a deep pit. He who is under the LORD's wrath will fall into it. ¹⁵Folly is bound up in the heart of a child; the rod of discipline drives it far from him. ¹⁶Whoever oppresses the poor for his own increase and whoever gives to the rich, both come to poverty. ¹⁷Turn your ear, and listen to the words of the wise. Apply your heart to my teaching. ¹⁸For it is a pleasant thing if you keep them within you, if all of them are ready on your lips. ¹⁹I teach you today, even you, so that your trust may be in the LORD. ²⁰Haven't I written to you thirty excellent things of counsel and knowledge, ²¹To teach you truth, reliable words, to give sound answers to the ones who sent you? ²²Don't exploit the poor because he is poor; and don't crush the needy in court; ²³for the LORD will plead their case, and plunder the life of those who plunder them. ²⁴Don't befriend a hot-tempered man. Don't associate with one who harbors anger, ²⁵lest you learn his ways and ensnare your soul. ²⁶Don't you be one of those who strike hands, of those who are collateral for debts. ²⁷If you don't have means to pay, why should he take away your bed from under you? ²⁸Don't move the ancient boundary stone which your fathers have set up. ²⁹Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will serve kings. He won't serve obscure men.

23When you sit to eat with a ruler, consider diligently what is before you; ²put a knife to your throat if you are a man given to appetite. ³Don't be desirous of his dainties, since they are deceitful food. ⁴Don't weary yourself to be rich. In your wisdom, show restraint. ⁵Why do you set

your eyes on that which is not? For it certainly sprouts wings like an eagle and flies in the sky. ⁶Don't eat the food of him who has a stingy eye, and don't crave his delicacies, ⁷for as he thinks about the cost, so he is. "Eat and drink!" he says to you, but his heart is not with you. ⁸You will vomit up the morsel which you have eaten and waste your pleasant words. ⁹Don't speak in the ears of a fool, for he will despise the wisdom of your words. ¹⁰Don't move the ancient boundary stone. Don't encroach on the fields of the fatherless, ¹¹for their Defender is strong. He will plead their case against you. ¹²Apply your heart to instruction, and your ears to the words of knowledge. ¹³Don't withhold correction from a child. If you punish him with the rod, he will not die. ¹⁴Punish him with the rod, and save his soul from Sheol. ^{xi} ¹⁵My son, if your heart is wise, then my heart will be glad, even mine. ¹⁶Yes, my heart will rejoice when your lips speak what is right. ¹⁷Don't let your heart envy sinners, but rather fear the LORD all day long. ¹⁸Indeed surely there is a future hope, and your hope will not be cut off. ¹⁹Listen, my son, and be wise, and keep your heart on the right path! ²⁰Don't be among ones drinking too much wine, or those who gorge themselves on meat; ²¹for the drunkard and the glutton shall become poor; and drowsiness clothes them in rags. ²²Listen to your father who gave you life, and don't despise your mother when she is old. ²³Buy the truth, and don't sell it. Get wisdom, discipline, and understanding. ²⁴The father of the righteous has great joy. Whoever fathers a wise child delights in him. ²⁵Let your father and your mother be glad! Let her who bore you rejoice! ²⁶My son, give me your heart; and let your eyes keep in my ways. ²⁷For a prostitute is a deep pit; and a wayward wife is a narrow well. ²⁸Yes, she lies in wait like a robber, and increases the unfaithful among men. ²⁹Who has woe? Who has sorrow? Who has strife? Who has complaints? Who has needless bruises? Who has bloodshot eyes? ³⁰Those who stay long at the wine; those who go to seek out mixed wine. ³¹Don't look at the wine when it is red, when it sparkles in the cup, when it goes down smoothly. ³²In the end, it bites like a snake, and poisons like a viper. ³³Your eyes will see strange things, and your mind will imagine confusing things. ³⁴Yes, you will be as he who lies down in the middle of the sea, or as he who lies on top of the rigging: ³⁵"They hit me, and I was not hurt! They beat me, and I don't feel it! When will I wake up? I can do it again. I will look for more."

24Don't be envious of evil men, neither desire to be with them; ²for their hearts plot violence and their lips talk about mischief. ³Through wisdom a house is built; by understanding it is established; ⁴by knowledge the rooms are filled with all rare and beautiful treasure. ⁵A wise man has great power. A knowledgeable man increases strength,

^{xi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

⁶for by wise guidance you wage your war, and victory is in many advisors. ⁷Wisdom is too high for a fool. He doesn't open his mouth in the gate. ⁸One who plots to do evil will be called a schemer. ⁹The schemes of folly are sin. The mocker is detested by men. ¹⁰If you falter in the time of trouble, your strength is small. ¹¹Rescue those who are being led away to death! Indeed, hold back those who are staggering to the slaughter! ¹²If you say, "Behold, we didn't know this," doesn't he who weighs the hearts consider it? He who keeps your soul, doesn't he know it? Shall he not render to every man according to his work? ¹³My son, eat honey, for it is good, the droppings of the honeycomb, which are sweet to your taste; ¹⁴so you shall know wisdom to be to your soul. If you have found it, then there will be a reward: Your hope will not be cut off. ¹⁵Don't lay in wait, wicked man, against the habitation of the righteous. Don't destroy his resting place; ¹⁶for a righteous man falls seven times and rises up again, but the wicked are overthrown by calamity. ¹⁷Don't rejoice when your enemy falls. Don't let your heart be glad when he is overthrown, ¹⁸lest the LORD see it, and it displease him, and he turn away his wrath from him. ¹⁹Don't fret yourself because of evildoers, neither be envious of the wicked; ²⁰for there will be no reward to the evil man. The lamp of the wicked will be snuffed out. ²¹My son, fear the LORD and the king. Don't join those who are rebellious, ²²for their calamity will rise suddenly. Who knows what destruction may come from them both? ²³These also are sayings of the wise: To show partiality in judgment is not good. ²⁴He who says to the wicked, "You are righteous," peoples will curse him, and nations will abhor him— ²⁵but it will go well with those who convict the guilty, and a rich blessing will come on them. ²⁶An honest answer is like a kiss on the lips. ²⁷Prepare your work outside, and get your fields ready. Afterwards, build your house. ²⁸Don't be a witness against your neighbor without cause. Don't deceive with your lips. ²⁹Don't say, "I will do to him as he has done to me; I will repay the man according to his work." ³⁰I went by the field of the sluggard, by the vineyard of the man void of understanding. ³¹Behold, it was all grown over with thorns. Its surface was covered with nettles, and its stone wall was broken down. ³²Then I saw, and considered well. I saw, and received instruction: ³³a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep, ³⁴so your poverty will come as a robber and your want as an armed man.

25These also are proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out. ²It is the glory of God to conceal a thing, but the glory of kings is to search out a matter. ³As the heavens for height, and the earth for depth, so the hearts of kings are unsearchable. ⁴Take away the dross from the silver, and material comes out for the refiner. ⁵Take away the wicked from the king's presence,

and his throne will be established in righteousness. ⁶Don't exalt yourself in the presence of the king, or claim a place among great men; ⁷for it is better that it be said to you, "Come up here," than that you should be put lower in the presence of the prince, whom your eyes have seen. ⁸Don't be hasty in bringing charges to court. What will you do in the end when your neighbor shames you? ⁹Debate your case with your neighbor, and don't betray the confidence of another, ¹⁰lest one who hears it put you to shame, and your bad reputation never depart. ¹¹A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in settings of silver. ¹²As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprover to an obedient ear. ¹³As the cold of snow in the time of harvest, so is a faithful messenger to those who send him; for he refreshes the soul of his masters. ¹⁴As clouds and wind without rain, so is he who boasts of gifts deceptively. ¹⁵By patience a ruler is persuaded. A soft tongue breaks the bone. ¹⁶Have you found honey? Eat as much as is sufficient for you, lest you eat too much, and vomit it. ¹⁷Let your foot be seldom in your neighbor's house, lest he be weary of you, and hate you. ¹⁸A man who gives false testimony against his neighbor is like a club, a sword, or a sharp arrow. ¹⁹Confidence in someone unfaithful in time of trouble is like a bad tooth or a lame foot. ²⁰As one who takes away a garment in cold weather, or vinegar on soda, so is one who sings songs to a heavy heart. ²¹If your enemy is hungry, give him food to eat. If he is thirsty, give him water to drink; ²²for you will heap coals of fire on his head, and the LORD will reward you. ²³The north wind produces rain; so a backbiting tongue brings an angry face. ²⁴It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop than to share a house with a contentious woman. ²⁵Like cold water to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a far country. ²⁶Like a muddied spring and a polluted well, so is a righteous man who gives way before the wicked. ²⁷It is not good to eat much honey, nor is it honorable to seek one's own honor. ²⁸Like a city that is broken down and without walls is a man whose spirit is without restraint.

26Like snow in summer, and as rain in harvest, so honor is not fitting for a fool. ²Like a fluttering sparrow, like a darting swallow, so the undeserved curse doesn't come to rest. ³A whip is for the horse, a bridle for the donkey, and a rod for the back of fools! ⁴Don't answer a fool according to his folly, lest you also be like him. ⁵Answer a fool according to his folly, lest he be wise in his own eyes. ⁶One who sends a message by the hand of a fool is cutting off feet and drinking violence. ⁷Like the legs of the lame that hang loose, so is a parable in the mouth of fools. ⁸As one who binds a stone in a sling, so is he who gives honor to a fool. ⁹Like a thorn bush that goes into the hand of a drunkard, so is a parable in the mouth of fools. ¹⁰As an archer who wounds all, so is he who hires a fool or he who hires those who pass by. ¹¹As a dog that returns to his vomit, so is

a fool who repeats his folly. ¹²Do you see a man wise in his own eyes? There is more hope for a fool than for him. ¹³The sluggard says, "There is a lion in the road! A fierce lion roams the streets!" ¹⁴As the door turns on its hinges, so does the sluggard on his bed. ¹⁵The sluggard buries his hand in the dish. He is too lazy to bring it back to his mouth. ¹⁶The sluggard is wiser in his own eyes than seven men who answer with discretion. ¹⁷Like one who grabs a dog's ears is one who passes by and meddles in a quarrel not his own. ¹⁸Like a madman who shoots torches, arrows, and death, ¹⁹is the man who deceives his neighbor and says, "Am I not joking?" ²⁰For lack of wood a fire goes out. Without gossip, a quarrel dies down. ²¹As coals are to hot embers, and wood to fire, so is a contentious man to kindling strife. ²²The words of a whisperer are as dainty morsels, they go down into the innermost parts. ²³Like silver dross on an earthen vessel are the lips of a fervent one with an evil heart. ²⁴A malicious man disguises himself with his lips, but he harbors evil in his heart. ²⁵When his speech is charming, don't believe him, for there are seven abominations in his heart. ²⁶His malice may be concealed by deception, but his wickedness will be exposed in the assembly. ²⁷Whoever digs a pit shall fall into it. Whoever rolls a stone, it will come back on him. ²⁸A lying tongue hates those it hurts; and a flattering mouth works ruin.

²⁷Don't boast about tomorrow; for you don't know what a day may bring. ²Let another man praise you, and not your own mouth; a stranger, and not your own lips. ³A stone is heavy, and sand is a burden; but a fool's provocation is heavier than both. ⁴Wrath is cruel, and anger is overwhelming; but who is able to stand before jealousy? ⁵Better is open rebuke than hidden love. ⁶The wounds of a friend are faithful, although the kisses of an enemy are profuse. ⁷A full soul loathes a honeycomb; but to a hungry soul, every bitter thing is sweet. ⁸As a bird that wanders from her nest, so is a man who wanders from his home. ⁹Perfume and incense bring joy to the heart; so does earnest counsel from a man's friend. ¹⁰Don't forsake your friend and your father's friend. Don't go to your brother's house in the day of your disaster. A neighbor who is near is better than a distant brother. ¹¹Be wise, my son, and bring joy to my heart, then I can answer my tormentor. ¹²A prudent man sees danger and takes refuge; but the simple pass on, and suffer for it. ¹³Take his garment when he puts up collateral for a stranger. Hold it for a wayward woman! ¹⁴He who blesses his neighbor with a loud voice early in the morning, it will be taken as a curse by him. ¹⁵A continual dropping on a rainy day and a contentious wife are alike: ¹⁶restraining her is like restraining the wind, or like grasping oil in his right hand. ¹⁷Iron sharpens iron; so a man sharpens his friend's countenance. ¹⁸Whoever tends the fig tree shall eat its fruit. He who looks after his master shall be honored. ¹⁹Like water reflects a face, so

a man's heart reflects the man. ²⁰Sheol ^{xii} and Abaddon are never satisfied; and a man's eyes are never satisfied. ²¹The crucible is for silver, and the furnace for gold; but man is refined by his praise. ²²Though you grind a fool in a mortar with a pestle along with grain, yet his foolishness will not be removed from him. ²³Know well the state of your flocks, and pay attention to your herds, ²⁴for riches are not forever, nor does the crown endure to all generations. ²⁵The hay is removed, and the new growth appears, the grasses of the hills are gathered in. ²⁶The lambs are for your clothing, and the goats are the price of a field. ²⁷There will be plenty of goats' milk for your food, for your family's food, and for the nourishment of your servant girls.

²⁸The wicked flee when no one pursues; but the righteous are as bold as a lion. ²In rebellion, a land has many rulers, but order is maintained by a man of understanding and knowledge. ³A needy man who oppresses the poor is like a driving rain which leaves no crops. ⁴Those who forsake the Torah praise the wicked; but those who keep the Torah contend with them. ⁵Evil men don't understand justice; but those who seek the LORD understand it fully. ⁶Better is the poor who walks in his integrity than he who is perverse in his ways, and he is rich. ⁷Whoever keeps the Torah is a wise son; but he who is a companion of gluttons shames his father. ⁸He who increases his wealth by excessive interest gathers it for one who has pity on the poor. ⁹He who turns away his ear from hearing the Torah, even his prayer is an abomination. ¹⁰Whoever causes the upright to go astray in an evil way, he will fall into his own trap; but the blameless will inherit good. ¹¹The rich man is wise in his own eyes; but the poor who has understanding sees through him. ¹²When the righteous triumph, there is great glory; but when the wicked rise, men hide themselves. ¹³He who conceals his sins doesn't prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them finds mercy. ¹⁴Blessed is the man who always fears; but one who hardens his heart falls into trouble. ¹⁵As a roaring lion or a charging bear, so is a wicked ruler over helpless people. ¹⁶A tyrannical ruler lacks judgment. One who hates ill-gotten gain will have long days. ¹⁷A man who is tormented by blood guilt will be a fugitive until death. No one will support him. ¹⁸Whoever walks blamelessly is kept safe; but one with perverse ways will fall suddenly. ¹⁹One who works his land will have an abundance of food; but one who chases fantasies will have his fill of poverty. ²⁰A faithful man is rich with blessings; but one who is eager to be rich will not go unpunished. ²¹To show partiality is not good, yet a man will do wrong for a piece of bread. ²²A stingy man hurries after riches, and doesn't know that poverty waits for him. ²³One who rebukes a man will afterward find more favor than one who flatters with the tongue. ²⁴Whoever

^{xii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

robs his father or his mother and says, "It's not wrong," is a partner with a destroyer. ²⁵One who is greedy stirs up strife; but one who trusts in the LORD will prosper. ²⁶One who trusts in himself is a fool; but one who walks in wisdom is kept safe. ²⁷One who gives to the poor has no lack; but one who closes his eyes will have many curses. ²⁸When the wicked rise, men hide themselves; but when they perish, the righteous thrive.

29He who is often rebuked and stiffens his neck will be destroyed suddenly, with no remedy. ²When the righteous thrive, the people rejoice; but when the wicked rule, the people groan. ³Whoever loves wisdom brings joy to his father; but a companion of prostitutes squanders his wealth. ⁴The king by justice makes the land stable, but he who takes bribes tears it down. ⁵A man who flatters his neighbor spreads a net for his feet. ⁶An evil man is snared by his sin, but the righteous can sing and be glad. ⁷The righteous care about justice for the poor. The wicked aren't concerned about knowledge. ⁸Mockers stir up a city, but wise men turn away anger. ⁹If a wise man goes to court with a foolish man, the fool rages or scoffs, and there is no peace. ¹⁰The bloodthirsty hate a man of integrity; and they seek the life of the upright. ¹¹A fool vents all of his anger, but a wise man brings himself under control. ¹²If a ruler listens to lies, all of his officials are wicked. ¹³The poor man and the oppressor have this in common: The LORD gives sight to the eyes of both. ¹⁴The king who fairly judges the poor, his throne shall be established forever. ¹⁵The rod of correction gives wisdom, but a child left to himself causes shame to his mother. ¹⁶When the wicked increase, sin increases; but the righteous will see their downfall. ¹⁷Correct your son, and he will give you peace; yes, he will bring delight to your soul. ¹⁸Where there is no revelation, the people cast off restraint; but one who keeps the Torah is blessed. ¹⁹A servant can't be corrected by words. Though he understands, yet he will not respond. ²⁰Do you see a man who is hasty in his words? There is more hope for a fool than for him. ²¹He who pampers his servant from youth will have him become a son in the end. ²²An angry man stirs up strife, and a wrathful man abounds in sin. ²³A man's pride brings him low, but one of lowly spirit gains honor. ²⁴Whoever is an accomplice of a thief is an enemy of his own soul. He takes an oath, but dares not testify. ²⁵The fear of man proves to be a snare, but whoever puts his trust in the LORD is kept safe. ²⁶Many seek the ruler's favor, but a man's justice comes from the LORD. ²⁷A dishonest man detests the righteous, and the upright in their ways detest the wicked.

30The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, the revelation: the man says to Ithiel, to Ithiel and Ucal: ²"Surely I am the most ignorant man, and don't have a man's understanding. ³I have not learned wisdom, neither do I have

the knowledge of the Holy One. ⁴Who has ascended up into heaven, and descended? Who has gathered the wind in his fists? Who has bound the waters in his garment? Who has established all the ends of the earth? What is his name, and what is his son's name, if you know? ⁵"Every word of God is flawless. He is a shield to those who take refuge in him. ⁶Don't you add to his words, lest he reprove you, and you be found a liar. ⁷"Two things I have asked of you. Don't deny me before I die. ⁸Remove far from me falsehood and lies. Give me neither poverty nor riches. Feed me with the food that is needful for me, ⁹lest I be full, deny you, and say, 'Who is the LORD?' or lest I be poor, and steal, and so dishonor the name of my God. ¹⁰"Don't slander a servant to his master, lest he curse you, and you be held guilty. ¹¹There is a generation that curses their father, and doesn't bless their mother. ¹²There is a generation that is pure in their own eyes, yet are not washed from their filthiness. ¹³There is a generation, oh how lofty are their eyes! Their eyelids are lifted up. ¹⁴There is a generation whose teeth are like swords, and their jaws like knives, to devour the poor from the earth, and the needy from among men. ¹⁵"The leech has two daughters: 'Give, give.' 'There are three things that are never satisfied; four that don't say, 'Enough!': ¹⁶Sheol, ^{xiii} the barren womb, the earth that is not satisfied with water, and the fire that doesn't say, 'Enough!' ¹⁷"The eye that mocks at his father, and scorns obedience to his mother, the ravens of the valley shall pick it out, the young eagles shall eat it. ¹⁸"There are three things which are too amazing for me, four which I don't understand: ¹⁹The way of an eagle in the air, the way of a serpent on a rock, the way of a ship in the middle of the sea, and the way of a man with a maiden. ²⁰"So is the way of an adulterous woman: She eats and wipes her mouth, and says, 'I have done nothing wrong.' ²¹"For three things the earth trembles, and under four, it can't bear up: ²²For a servant when he is king, a fool when he is filled with food, ²³for an unloved woman when she is married, and a servant who is heir to her mistress. ²⁴"There are four things which are little on the earth, but they are exceedingly wise: ²⁵The ants are not a strong people, yet they provide their food in the summer. ²⁶The hyraxes are but a feeble folk, yet make they their houses in the rocks. ²⁷The locusts have no king, yet they advance in ranks. ²⁸You can catch a lizard with your hands, yet it is in kings' palaces. ²⁹"There are three things which are stately in their march, four which are stately in going: ³⁰The lion, which is mightiest among animals, and doesn't turn away for any; ³¹the greyhound; the male goat; and the king against whom there is no rising up. ³²"If you have done foolishly in lifting up yourself, or if you have thought evil, put your hand over your mouth. ³³For as the churning of milk produces butter, and the wringing of the nose produces blood, so the forcing of wrath produces

^{xiii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

strife.”

31The words of King Lemuel—the revelation which his mother taught him: ²“Oh, my son! Oh, son of my womb! Oh, son of my vows! ³Don’t give your strength to women, nor your ways to that which destroys kings. ⁴It is not for kings, Lemuel, it is not for kings to drink wine, nor for princes to say, ‘Where is strong drink?’ ⁵lest they drink, and forget the decree, and pervert the justice due to anyone who is afflicted. ⁶Give strong drink to him who is ready to perish, and wine to the bitter in soul. ⁷Let him drink, and forget his poverty, and remember his misery no more. ⁸Open your mouth for the mute, in the cause of all who are left desolate. ⁹Open your mouth, judge righteously, and serve justice to the poor and needy.” ^{10xiv} Who can find a worthy woman? For her value is far above rubies. ¹¹The heart of her husband trusts in her. He shall have no lack of gain. ¹²She does him good, and not harm, all the days of her life. ¹³She seeks wool and flax, and works eagerly with her hands. ¹⁴She is like the merchant ships. She brings her bread from afar. ¹⁵She rises also while it is yet night, gives food to her household, and portions for her servant girls. ¹⁶She considers a field, and buys it. With the fruit of her hands, she plants a vineyard. ¹⁷She arms her waist with strength, and makes her arms strong. ¹⁸She perceives that her merchandise is profitable. Her lamp doesn’t go out by night. ¹⁹She lays her hands to the distaff, and her hands hold the spindle. ²⁰She opens her arms to the poor; yes, she extends her hands to the needy. ²¹She is not afraid of the snow for her household, for all her household are clothed with scarlet. ²²She makes for herself carpets of tapestry. Her clothing is fine linen and purple. ²³Her husband is respected in the gates, when he sits among the elders of the land. ²⁴She makes linen garments and sells them, and delivers sashes to the merchant. ²⁵Strength and dignity are her clothing. She laughs at the time to come. ²⁶She opens her mouth with wisdom. Kind instruction is on her tongue. ²⁷She looks well to the ways of her household, and doesn’t eat the bread of idleness. ²⁸Her children rise up and call her blessed. Her husband also praises her: ²⁹“Many women do noble things, but you excel them all.” ³⁰Charm is deceitful, and beauty is vain; but a woman who fears the LORD, she shall be praised. ³¹Give her of the fruit of her hands! Let her works praise her in the gates!

Ecclesiastes

¹The words of Kohelet ⁱ, the Preacher (or, Assembler) the son of David, king in Jerusalem: ²“Vanity of vanities,” says Kohelet ⁱⁱ; “the Preacher (or, Assembler) Vanity of vanities, all is vanity.” ³What does man gain from all his labor in which he labors under the sun? ⁴One generation goes, and another generation comes; but the earth remains forever. ⁵The sun also rises, and the sun goes down, and hurries to its place where it rises. ⁶The wind goes toward the south, and turns around to the north. It turns around continually as it goes, and the wind returns again to its courses. ⁷All the rivers run into the sea, yet the sea is not full. To the place where the rivers flow, there they flow again. ⁸All things are full of weariness beyond uttering. The eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing. ⁹That which has been is that which shall be, and that which has been done is that which shall be done; and there is no new thing under the sun. ¹⁰Is there a thing of which it may be said, “Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ this is new?” It has been long ago, in the ages which were before us. ¹¹There is no memory of the former; neither shall there be any memory of the latter that are to come, among those that shall come after. ¹²I, Kohelet ^{iv}, the Preacher (or, Assembler) was king over Israel in Jerusalem. ¹³I applied my heart to seek and to search out by wisdom concerning all that is done under the sky. It is a heavy burden that God ^v has given to the sons of men to be afflicted with. ¹⁴I have seen all the works that are done under the sun; and behold, all is vanity and a chasing after wind. ¹⁵That which is crooked can’t be made straight; and that which is lacking can’t be counted. ¹⁶I said to myself, “Behold, I have obtained for myself great wisdom above all who were before me in Jerusalem. Yes, my heart has had great experience of wisdom and knowledge.” ¹⁷I applied my heart to know wisdom, and to know madness and folly. I perceived that this also was a chasing after wind. ¹⁸For in much wisdom is much grief; and he who increases knowledge increases sorrow.

ⁱthe Preacher (or, Assembler),

ⁱⁱthe Preacher (or, Assembler); “

ⁱⁱⁱ“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}the Preacher (or, Assembler),

^vThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is ” “ (Elohim).

²I said in my heart, “Come now, I will test you with mirth; therefore enjoy pleasure;” and behold, this also was vanity. ²I said of laughter, “It is foolishness;” and of mirth, “What does it accomplish?” ³I searched in my heart how to cheer my flesh with wine, my heart yet guiding me with wisdom, and how to lay hold of folly, until I might see what it was good for the sons of men that they should do under heaven all the days of their lives. ⁴I made myself great works. I built myself houses. I planted myself vineyards. ⁵I made myself gardens and parks, and I planted trees in them of all kinds of fruit. ⁶I made myself pools of water, to water the forest where trees were grown. ⁷I bought male servants and female servants, and had servants born in my house. I also had great possessions of herds and flocks, above all who were before me in Jerusalem. ⁸I also gathered silver and gold for myself, and the treasure of kings and of the provinces. I got myself male and female singers, and the delights of the sons of men: musical instruments of all sorts. ⁹So I was great, and increased more than all who were before me in Jerusalem. My wisdom also remained with me. ¹⁰Whatever my eyes desired, I didn’t keep from them. I didn’t withhold my heart from any joy, for my heart rejoiced because of all my labor, and this was my portion from all my labor. ¹¹Then I looked at all the works that my hands had worked, and at the labor that I had labored to do; and behold, all was vanity and a chasing after wind, and there was no profit under the sun. ¹²I turned myself to consider wisdom, madness, and folly; for what can the king’s successor do? Just that which has been done long ago. ¹³Then I saw that wisdom excels folly, as far as light excels darkness. ¹⁴The wise man’s eyes are in his head, and the fool walks in darkness—and yet I perceived that one event happens to them all. ¹⁵Then I said in my heart, “As it happens to the fool, so will it happen even to me; and why was I then more wise?” Then I said in my heart that this also is vanity. ¹⁶For of the wise man, even as of the fool, there is no memory forever, since in the days to come all will have been long forgotten. Indeed, the wise man must die just like the fool! ¹⁷So I hated life, because the work that is worked under the sun was grievous to me; for all is vanity and a chasing after wind. ¹⁸I hated all my labor in which I labored under the sun,

because I must leave it to the man who comes after me. ¹⁹Who knows whether he will be a wise man or a fool? Yet he will have rule over all of my labor in which I have labored, and in which I have shown myself wise under the sun. This also is vanity. ²⁰Therefore I began to cause my heart to despair concerning all the labor in which I had labored under the sun. ²¹For there is a man whose labor is with wisdom, with knowledge, and with skillfulness; yet he shall leave it for his portion to a man who has not labored for it. This also is vanity and a great evil. ²²For what does a man have of all his labor and of the striving of his heart, in which he labors under the sun? ²³For all his days are sorrows, and his travail is grief; yes, even in the night his heart takes no rest. This also is vanity. ²⁴There is nothing better for a man than that he should eat and drink, and make his soul enjoy good in his labor. This also I saw, that it is from the hand of God. ²⁵For who can eat, or who can have enjoyment, more than I? ²⁶For to the man who pleases him, God gives wisdom, knowledge, and joy; but to the sinner he gives travail, to gather and to heap up, that he may give to him who pleases God. This also is vanity and a chasing after wind.

3For everything there is a season, and a time for every purpose under heaven: ²a time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted; ³a time to kill, and a time to heal; a time to break down, and a time to build up; ⁴a time to weep, and a time to laugh; a time to mourn, and a time to dance; ⁵a time to cast away stones, and a time to gather stones together; a time to embrace, and a time to refrain from embracing; ⁶a time to seek, and a time to lose; a time to keep, and a time to cast away; ⁷a time to tear, and a time to sew; a time to keep silence, and a time to speak; ⁸a time to love, and a time to hate; a time for war, and a time for peace. ⁹What profit has he who works in that in which he labors? ¹⁰I have seen the burden which God has given to the sons of men to be afflicted with. ¹¹He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in their hearts, yet so that man can't find out the work that God has done from the beginning even to the end. ¹²I know that there is nothing better for them than to rejoice, and to do good as long as they live. ¹³Also that every man should eat and drink, and enjoy good in all his labor, is the gift of God. ¹⁴I know that whatever God does, it shall be forever. Nothing can be added to it, nor anything taken from it; and God has done it, that men should fear before him. ¹⁵That which is has been long ago, and that which is to be has been long ago. God seeks again that which is passed away. ¹⁶Moreover I saw under the sun, in the place of justice, that wickedness was there; and in the place of righteousness, that wickedness was there. ¹⁷I said in my heart, "God will judge the righteous and the wicked; for there is a time there for every purpose and for

every work." ¹⁸I said in my heart, "As for the sons of men, God tests them, so that they may see that they themselves are like animals. ¹⁹For that which happens to the sons of men happens to animals. Even one thing happens to them. As the one dies, so the other dies. Yes, they have all one breath; and man has no advantage over the animals, for all is vanity. ²⁰All go to one place. All are from the dust, and all turn to dust again. ²¹Who knows the spirit of man, whether it goes upward, and the spirit of the animal, whether it goes downward to the earth?" ²²Therefore I saw that there is nothing better than that a man should rejoice in his works, for that is his portion; for who can bring him to see what will be after him?

4Then I returned and saw all the oppressions that are done under the sun: and behold, the tears of those who were oppressed, and they had no comforter; and on the side of their oppressors there was power; but they had no comforter. ²Therefore I praised the dead who have been long dead more than the living who are yet alive. ³Yes, better than them both is him who has not yet been, who has not seen the evil work that is done under the sun. ⁴Then I saw all the labor and achievement that is the envy of a man's neighbor. This also is vanity and a striving after wind. ⁵The fool folds his hands together and ruins himself. ⁶Better is a handful, with quietness, than two handfuls with labor and chasing after wind. ⁷Then I returned and saw vanity under the sun. ⁸There is one who is alone, and he has neither son nor brother. There is no end to all of his labor, neither are his eyes satisfied with wealth. "For whom then do I labor and deprive my soul of enjoyment?" This also is vanity. Yes, it is a miserable business. ⁹Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their labor. ¹⁰For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow; but woe to him who is alone when he falls, and doesn't have another to lift him up. ¹¹Again, if two lie together, then they have warmth; but how can one keep warm alone? ¹²If a man prevails against one who is alone, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken. ¹³Better is a poor and wise youth than an old and foolish king who doesn't know how to receive admonition any more. ¹⁴For out of prison he came out to be king; yes, even in his kingdom he was born poor. ¹⁵I saw all the living who walk under the sun, that they were with the youth, the other, who succeeded him. ¹⁶There was no end of all the people, even of all them over whom he was—yet those who come after shall not rejoice in him. Surely this also is vanity and a chasing after wind.

5Guard your steps when you go to God's house; for to draw near to listen is better than to give the sacrifice of fools, for they don't know that they do evil. ²Don't be rash with your mouth, and don't let your heart be hasty to utter anything before God; for God is in heaven, and

you on earth. Therefore let your words be few. ³For as a dream comes with a multitude of cares, so a fool's speech with a multitude of words. ⁴When you vow a vow to God, don't defer to pay it; for he has no pleasure in fools. Pay that which you vow. ⁵It is better that you should not vow, than that you should vow and not pay. ⁶Don't allow your mouth to lead you into sin. Don't protest before the messenger that this was a mistake. Why should God be angry at your voice, and destroy the work of your hands? ⁷For in the multitude of dreams there are vanities, as well as in many words; but you must fear God. ⁸If you see the oppression of the poor, and the violent taking away of justice and righteousness in a district, don't marvel at the matter, for one official is eyed by a higher one, and there are officials over them. ⁹Moreover the profit of the earth is for all. The king profits from the field. ¹⁰He who loves silver shall not be satisfied with silver, nor he who loves abundance, with increase. This also is vanity. ¹¹When goods increase, those who eat them are increased; and what advantage is there to its owner, except to feast on them with his eyes? ¹²The sleep of a laboring man is sweet, whether he eats little or much; but the abundance of the rich will not allow him to sleep. ¹³There is a grievous evil which I have seen under the sun: wealth kept by its owner to his harm. ¹⁴Those riches perish by misfortune, and if he has fathered a son, there is nothing in his hand. ¹⁵As he came out of his mother's womb, naked shall he go again as he came, and shall take nothing for his labor, which he may carry away in his hand. ¹⁶This also is a grievous evil, that in all points as he came, so shall he go. And what profit does he have who labors for the wind? ¹⁷All his days he also eats in darkness, he is frustrated, and has sickness and wrath. ¹⁸Behold, that which I have seen to be good and proper is for one to eat and to drink, and to enjoy good in all his labor, in which he labors under the sun, all the days of his life which God has given him; for this is his portion. ¹⁹Every man also to whom God has given riches and wealth, and has given him power to eat of it, and to take his portion, and to rejoice in his labor—this is the gift of God. ²⁰For he shall not often reflect on the days of his life, because God occupies him with the joy of his heart.

6 There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, and it is heavy on men: ²a man to whom God gives riches, wealth, and honor, so that he lacks nothing for his soul of all that he desires, yet God gives him no power to eat of it, but an alien eats it. This is vanity, and it is an evil disease. ³If a man fathers a hundred children, and lives many years, so that the days of his years are many, but his soul is not filled with good, and moreover he has no burial, I say that a stillborn child is better than he; ⁴for it comes in vanity, and departs in darkness, and its name is covered with darkness. ⁵Moreover it has not seen the sun nor known it. This has

rest rather than the other. ⁶Yes, though he live a thousand years twice told, and yet fails to enjoy good, don't all go to one place? ⁷All the labor of man is for his mouth, and yet the appetite is not filled. ⁸For what advantage has the wise more than the fool? What has the poor man, that knows how to walk before the living? ⁹Better is the sight of the eyes than the wandering of the desire. This also is vanity and a chasing after wind. ¹⁰Whatever has been, its name was given long ago; and it is known what man is; neither can he contend with him who is mightier than he. ¹¹For there are many words that create vanity. What does that profit man? ¹²For who knows what is good for man in life, all the days of his vain life which he spends like a shadow? For who can tell a man what will be after him under the sun?

7 A good name is better than fine perfume; and the day of death better than the day of one's birth. ²It is better to go to the house of mourning than to go to the house of feasting; for that is the end of all men, and the living should take this to heart. ³Sorrow is better than laughter; for by the sadness of the face the heart is made good. ⁴The heart of the wise is in the house of mourning; but the heart of fools is in the house of mirth. ⁵It is better to hear the rebuke of the wise than for a man to hear the song of fools. ⁶For as the crackling of thorns under a pot, so is the laughter of the fool. This also is vanity. ⁷Surely extortion makes the wise man foolish; and a bribe destroys the understanding. ⁸Better is the end of a thing than its beginning. The patient in spirit is better than the proud in spirit. ⁹Don't be hasty in your spirit to be angry, for anger rests in the bosom of fools. ¹⁰Don't say, "Why were the former days better than these?" For you do not ask wisely about this. ¹¹Wisdom is as good as an inheritance. Yes, it is more excellent for those who see the sun. ¹²For wisdom is a defense, even as money is a defense; but the excellency of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of him who has it. ¹³Consider the work of God, for who can make that straight which he has made crooked? ¹⁴In the day of prosperity be joyful, and in the day of adversity consider; yes, God has made the one side by side with the other, to the end that man should not find out anything after him. ¹⁵All this I have seen in my days of vanity: there is a righteous man who perishes in his righteousness, and there is a wicked man who lives long in his evildoing. ¹⁶Don't be overly righteous, neither make yourself overly wise. Why should you destroy yourself? ¹⁷Don't be too wicked, neither be foolish. Why should you die before your time? ¹⁸It is good that you should take hold of this. Yes, also don't withdraw your hand from that; for he who fears God will come out of them all. ¹⁹Wisdom is a strength to the wise man more than ten rulers who are in a city. ²⁰Surely there is not a righteous man on earth who does good and doesn't sin. ²¹Also don't take heed to all words

that are spoken, lest you hear your servant curse you; ²²for often your own heart knows that you yourself have likewise cursed others. ²³All this I have proved in wisdom. I said, “I will be wise;” but it was far from me. ²⁴That which is, is far off and exceedingly deep. Who can find it out? ²⁵I turned around, and my heart sought to know and to search out, and to seek wisdom and the scheme of things, and to know that wickedness is stupidity, and that foolishness is madness. ²⁶I find more bitter than death the woman whose heart is snares and traps, whose hands are chains. Whoever pleases God shall escape from her; but the sinner will be ensnared by her. ²⁷“Behold, I have found this,” says Kohelet ^{vi}, “the Preacher (or, Assembler) to one another, to find an explanation ²⁸which my soul still seeks, but I have not found. I have found one man among a thousand, but I have not found a woman among all those. ²⁹Behold, I have only found this: that God made mankind upright; but they search for many inventions.”

⁸Who is like the wise man? And who knows the interpretation of a thing? A man’s wisdom makes his face shine, and the hardness of his face is changed. ²I say, “Keep the king’s command!” because of the oath to God. ³Don’t be hasty to go out of his presence. Don’t persist in an evil thing, for he does whatever pleases him, ⁴for the king’s word is supreme. Who can say to him, “What are you doing?” ⁵Whoever keeps the commandment shall not come to harm, and his wise heart will know the time and procedure. ⁶For there is a time and procedure for every purpose, although the misery of man is heavy on him. ⁷For he doesn’t know that which will be; for who can tell him how it will be? ⁸There is no man who has power over the spirit to contain the spirit; neither does he have power over the day of death. There is no discharge in war; neither shall wickedness deliver those who practice it. ⁹All this I have seen, and applied my mind to every work that is done under the sun. There is a time in which one man has power over another to his hurt. ¹⁰So I saw the wicked buried. Indeed they came also from holiness. They went and were forgotten in the city where they did this. This also is vanity. ¹¹Because sentence against an evil work is not executed speedily, therefore the heart of the sons of men is fully set in them to do evil. ¹²Though a sinner commits crimes a hundred times, and lives long, yet surely I know that it will be better with those who fear God, who are reverent before him. ¹³But it shall not be well with the wicked, neither shall he lengthen days like a shadow, because he doesn’t fear God. ¹⁴There is a vanity which is done on the earth, that there are righteous men to whom it happens according to the work of the wicked. Again, there are wicked men to whom it happens according to the work of the righteous. I said that this also is vanity. ¹⁵Then I commended mirth, because a man has no better

thing under the sun than to eat, to drink, and to be joyful: for that will accompany him in his labor all the days of his life which God has given him under the sun. ¹⁶When I applied my heart to know wisdom, and to see the business that is done on the earth (even though eyes see no sleep day or night), ¹⁷then I saw all the work of God, that man can’t find out the work that is done under the sun, because however much a man labors to seek it out, yet he won’t find it. Yes even though a wise man thinks he can comprehend it, he won’t be able to find it.

⁹For all this I laid to my heart, even to explore all this: that the righteous, and the wise, and their works, are in the hand of God; whether it is love or hatred, man doesn’t know it; all is before them. ²All things come alike to all. There is one event to the righteous and to the wicked; to the good, to the clean, to the unclean, to him who sacrifices, and to him who doesn’t sacrifice. As is the good, so is the sinner; he who takes an oath, as he who fears an oath. ³This is an evil in all that is done under the sun, that there is one event to all. Yes also, the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and madness is in their heart while they live, and after that they go to the dead. ⁴For to him who is joined with all the living there is hope; for a living dog is better than a dead lion. ⁵For the living know that they will die, but the dead don’t know anything, neither do they have any more a reward; for their memory is forgotten. ⁶Also their love, their hatred, and their envy has perished long ago; neither do they any longer have a portion forever in anything that is done under the sun. ⁷Go your way—eat your bread with joy, and drink your wine with a merry heart; for God has already accepted your works. ⁸Let your garments be always white, and don’t let your head lack oil. ⁹Live joyfully with the wife whom you love all the days of your life of vanity, which he has given you under the sun, all your days of vanity, for that is your portion in life, and in your labor in which you labor under the sun. ¹⁰Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work, nor plan, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in Sheol, ^{vii} where you are going. ¹¹I returned and saw under the sun that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favor to men of skill; but time and chance happen to them all. ¹²For man also doesn’t know his time. As the fish that are taken in an evil net, and as the birds that are caught in the snare, even so are the sons of men snared in an evil time, when it falls suddenly on them. ¹³I have also seen wisdom under the sun in this way, and it seemed great to me. ¹⁴There was a little city, and few men within it; and a great king came against it, besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it. ¹⁵Now a poor wise man was found in it, and he by his wisdom delivered the city; yet no man

^{vi}the Preacher (or, Assembler), “

^{vii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

remembered that same poor man. ¹⁶Then I said, “Wisdom is better than strength.” Nevertheless the poor man’s wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard. ¹⁷The words of the wise heard in quiet are better than the cry of him who rules among fools. ¹⁸Wisdom is better than weapons of war; but one sinner destroys much good.

10Dead flies cause the oil of the perfumer to produce an evil odor; so does a little folly outweigh wisdom and honor. ²A wise man’s heart is at his right hand, but a fool’s heart at his left. ³Yes also when the fool walks by the way, his understanding fails him, and he says to everyone that he is a fool. ⁴If the spirit of the ruler rises up against you, don’t leave your place; for gentleness lays great offenses to rest. ⁵There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, the sort of error which proceeds from the ruler. ⁶Folly is set in great dignity, and the rich sit in a low place. ⁷I have seen servants on horses, and princes walking like servants on the earth. ⁸He who digs a pit may fall into it; and whoever breaks through a wall may be bitten by a snake. ⁹Whoever carves out stones may be injured by them. Whoever splits wood may be endangered by it. ¹⁰If the ax is blunt, and one doesn’t sharpen the edge, then he must use more strength; but skill brings success. ¹¹If the snake bites before it is charmed, then is there no profit for the charmer’s tongue. ¹²The words of a wise man’s mouth are gracious; but a fool is swallowed by his own lips. ¹³The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness; and the end of his talk is mischievous madness. ¹⁴A fool also multiplies words. Man doesn’t know what will be; and that which will be after him, who can tell him? ¹⁵The labor of fools wearies every one of them; for he doesn’t know how to go to the city. ¹⁶Woe to you, land, when your king is a child, and your princes eat in the morning! ¹⁷Happy are you, land, when your king is the son of nobles, and your princes eat in due season, for strength, and not for drunkenness! ¹⁸By slothfulness the roof sinks in; and through idleness of the hands the house leaks. ¹⁹A feast is made for laughter, and wine makes the life glad; and money is the answer for all things. ²⁰Don’t curse the king, no, not in your thoughts; and don’t curse the rich in your bedroom, for a bird of the sky may carry your voice, and that which has wings may tell the matter.

11Cast your bread on the waters; for you shall find it after many days. ²Give a portion to seven, yes, even to eight; for you don’t know what evil will be on the earth. ³If the clouds are full of rain, they empty themselves on the earth; and if a tree falls toward the south, or toward the north, in the place where the tree falls, there shall it be. ⁴He who observes the wind won’t sow; and he who regards the clouds won’t reap. ⁵As you don’t know what is the way of the wind, nor how the bones grow in the womb of her who is with child; even so you don’t know the work of

God who does all. ⁶In the morning sow your seed, and in the evening don’t withhold your hand; for you don’t know which will prosper, whether this or that, or whether they both will be equally good. ⁷Truly the light is sweet, and it is a pleasant thing for the eyes to see the sun. ⁸Yes, if a man lives many years, let him rejoice in them all; but let him remember the days of darkness, for they shall be many. All that comes is vanity. ⁹Rejoice, young man, in your youth, and let your heart cheer you in the days of your youth, and walk in the ways of your heart, and in the sight of your eyes; but know that for all these things God will bring you into judgment. ¹⁰Therefore remove sorrow from your heart, and put away evil from your flesh; for youth and the dawn of life are vanity.

12Remember also your Creator in the days of your youth, before the evil days come, and the years draw near, when you will say, “I have no pleasure in them;” ²Before the sun, the light, the moon, and the stars are darkened, and the clouds return after the rain; ³in the day when the keepers of the house shall tremble, and the strong men shall bow themselves, and the grinders cease because they are few, and those who look out of the windows are darkened, ⁴and the doors shall be shut in the street; when the sound of the grinding is low, and one shall rise up at the voice of a bird, and all the daughters of music shall be brought low; ⁵yes, they shall be afraid of heights, and terrors will be on the way; and the almond tree shall blossom, and the grasshopper shall be a burden, and desire shall fail; because man goes to his everlasting home, and the mourners go about the streets; ⁶before the silver cord is severed, or the golden bowl is broken, or the pitcher is broken at the spring, or the wheel broken at the cistern, ⁷and the dust returns to the earth as it was, and the spirit returns to God who gave it. ⁸“Vanity of vanities,” says Kohelet ^{viii} . the Preacher (or, Assembler) “All is vanity!” ⁹Further, because Kohelet ^{ix} the Preacher (or, Assembler) was wise, he still taught the people knowledge. Yes, he pondered, sought out, and set in order many proverbs. ¹⁰The Preacher sought to find out acceptable words, and that which was written blamelessly, words of truth. ¹¹The words of the wise are like goads; and like nails well fastened are words from the masters of assemblies, which are given from one shepherd. ¹²Furthermore, my son, be admonished: of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh. ¹³This is the end of the matter. All has been heard. Fear God and keep his commandments; for this is the whole duty of man. ¹⁴For God will bring every work into judgment, with every hidden thing, whether it is good, or whether it is evil.

^{viii}the Preacher (or, Assembler).

^{ix}the Preacher (or, Assembler)

Song of Solomon

¹The Song of songs, which is Solomon's. ²Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth; for your love is better than wine. ³Your oils have a pleasing fragrance. Your name is oil poured out, therefore the virgins love you. ⁴Take me away with you. Let's hurry. The king has brought me into his rooms. Friends We will be glad and rejoice in you. We will praise your love more than wine! Beloved They are right to love you. ⁵I am dark, but lovely, you daughters of Jerusalem, like Kedar's tents, like Solomon's curtains. ⁶Don't stare at me because I am dark, because the sun has scorched me. My mother's sons were angry with me. They made me keeper of the vineyards. I haven't kept my own vineyard. ⁷Tell me, you whom my soul loves, where you graze your flock, where you rest them at noon; for why should I be as one who is veiled beside the flocks of your companions? ⁸If you don't know, most beautiful among women, follow the tracks of the sheep. Graze your young goats beside the shepherds' tents. ⁹I have compared you, my love, to a steed in Pharaoh's chariots. ¹⁰Your cheeks are beautiful with earrings, your neck with strings of jewels. ¹¹We will make you earrings of gold, with studs of silver. ¹²While the king sat at his table, my perfume spread its fragrance. ¹³My beloved is to me a sachet of myrrh, that lies between my breasts. ¹⁴My beloved is to me a cluster of henna blossoms from the vineyards of En Gedi. ¹⁵Behold, ⁱ you are beautiful, my love. Behold, you are beautiful. Your eyes are like doves. ¹⁶Behold, you are beautiful, my beloved, yes, pleasant; and our couch is verdant. ¹⁷The beams of our house are cedars. Our rafters are firs.

²I am a rose of Sharon, a lily of the valleys. ²As a lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters. ³As the apple tree among the trees of the wood, so is my beloved among the sons. I sat down under his shadow with great delight, his fruit was sweet to my taste. ⁴He brought me to the banquet hall. His banner over me is love. ⁵Strengthen me with raisins, refresh me with apples; for I am faint with love. ⁶His left hand is under my head. His right hand embraces me. ⁷I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, or by the hinds of the field, that you not stir

up, nor awaken love, until it so desires. ⁸The voice of my beloved! Behold, he comes, leaping on the mountains, skipping on the hills. ⁹My beloved is like a roe or a young deer. Behold, he stands behind our wall! He looks in at the windows. He glances through the lattice. ¹⁰My beloved spoke, and said to me, "Rise up, my love, my beautiful one, and come away. ¹¹For behold, the winter is past. The rain is over and gone. ¹²The flowers appear on the earth. The time of the singing has come, and the voice of the turtledove is heard in our land. ¹³The fig tree ripens her green figs. The vines are in blossom. They give out their fragrance. Arise, my love, my beautiful one, and come away." ¹⁴My dove in the clefts of the rock, in the hiding places of the mountainside, let me see your face. Let me hear your voice; for your voice is sweet and your face is lovely. ¹⁵Catch for us the foxes, the little foxes that plunder the vineyards; for our vineyards are in blossom. ¹⁶My beloved is mine, and I am his. He browses among the lilies. ¹⁷Until the day is cool, and the shadows flee away, turn, my beloved, and be like a roe or a young deer on the mountains of Bether.

³By night on my bed, I sought him whom my soul loves. I sought him, but I didn't find him. ²I will get up now, and go about the city; in the streets and in the squares I will seek him whom my soul loves. I sought him, but I didn't find him. ³The watchmen who go about the city found me; "Have you seen him whom my soul loves?" ⁴I had scarcely passed from them, when I found him whom my soul loves. I held him, and would not let him go, until I had brought him into my mother's house, into the room of her who conceived me. ⁵I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, or by the hinds of the field, that you not stir up nor awaken love, until it so desires. ⁶Who is this who comes up from the wilderness like pillars of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, with all spices of the merchant? ⁷Behold, it is Solomon's carriage! Sixty mighty men are around it, of the mighty men of Israel. ⁸They all handle the sword, and are expert in war. Every man has his sword on his thigh, because of fear in the night. ⁹King Solomon made himself a carriage of the wood of Lebanon. ¹⁰He made its pillars of silver, its bottom of gold, its seat of purple, the middle of it being paved with love,

ⁱ"Behold", from , " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

from the daughters of Jerusalem. ¹¹Go out, you daughters of Zion, and see King Solomon, with the crown with which his mother has crowned him, in the day of his weddings, in the day of the gladness of his heart.

⁴Behold, you are beautiful, my love. Behold, you are beautiful. Your eyes are like doves behind your veil. Your hair is as a flock of goats, that descend from Mount Gilead. ²Your teeth are like a newly shorn flock, which have come up from the washing, where every one of them has twins. None is bereaved among them. ³Your lips are like scarlet thread. Your mouth is lovely. Your temples are like a piece of a pomegranate behind your veil. ⁴Your neck is like David's tower built for an armory, on which a thousand shields hang, all the shields of the mighty men. ⁵Your two breasts are like two fawns that are twins of a roe, which feed among the lilies. ⁶Until the day is cool, and the shadows flee away, I will go to the mountain of myrrh, to the hill of frankincense. ⁷You are all beautiful, my love. There is no spot in you. ⁸Come with me from Lebanon, my bride, with me from Lebanon. Look from the top of Amana, from the top of Senir and Hermon, from the lions' dens, from the mountains of the leopards. ⁹You have ravished my heart, my sister, my bride. You have ravished my heart with one of your eyes, with one chain of your neck. ¹⁰How beautiful is your love, my sister, my bride! How much better is your love than wine, the fragrance of your perfumes than all kinds of spices! ¹¹Your lips, my bride, drip like the honeycomb. Honey and milk are under your tongue. The smell of your garments is like the smell of Lebanon. ¹²My sister, my bride, is a locked up garden; a locked up spring, a sealed fountain. ¹³Your shoots are an orchard of pomegranates, with precious fruits, henna with spikenard plants, ¹⁴spikenard and saffron, calamus and cinnamon, with every kind of incense tree; myrrh and aloes, with all the best spices, ¹⁵a fountain of gardens, a well of living waters, flowing streams from Lebanon. ¹⁶Awake, north wind, and come, you south! Blow on my garden, that its spices may flow out. Let my beloved come into his garden, and taste his precious fruits.

⁵I have come into my garden, my sister, my bride. I have gathered my myrrh with my spice; I have eaten my honeycomb with my honey; I have drunk my wine with my milk. Friends Eat, friends! Drink, yes, drink abundantly, beloved. ²I was asleep, but my heart was awake. It is the voice of my beloved who knocks: "Open to me, my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled; for my head is filled with dew, and my hair with the dampness of the night." ³I have taken off my robe. Indeed, must I put it on? I have washed my feet. Indeed, must I soil them? ⁴My beloved thrust his hand in through the latch opening. My heart pounded for him. ⁵I rose up to open for my beloved. My hands dripped with myrrh, my fingers with liquid myrrh,

on the handles of the lock. ⁶I opened to my beloved; but my beloved left, and had gone away. My heart went out when he spoke. I looked for him, but I didn't find him. I called him, but he didn't answer. ⁷The watchmen who go about the city found me. They beat me. They bruised me. The keepers of the walls took my cloak away from me. ⁸I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem, If you find my beloved, that you tell him that I am faint with love. ⁹How is your beloved better than another beloved, you fairest among women? How is your beloved better than another beloved, that you do so adjure us? ¹⁰My beloved is white and ruddy. The best among ten thousand. ¹¹His head is like the purest gold. His hair is bushy, black as a raven. ¹²His eyes are like doves beside the water brooks, washed with milk, mounted like jewels. ¹³His cheeks are like a bed of spices with towers of perfumes. His lips are like lilies, dropping liquid myrrh. ¹⁴His hands are like rings of gold set with beryl. His body is like ivory work overlaid with sapphires. ¹⁵His legs are like pillars of marble set on sockets of fine gold. His appearance is like Lebanon, excellent as the cedars. ¹⁶His mouth is sweetness; yes, he is altogether lovely. This is my beloved, and this is my friend, daughters of Jerusalem.

⁶Where has your beloved gone, you fairest among women? Where has your beloved turned, that we may seek him with you? ²My beloved has gone down to his garden, to the beds of spices, to pasture his flock in the gardens, and to gather lilies. ³I am my beloved's, and my beloved is mine. He browses among the lilies. ⁴You are beautiful, my love, as Tirzah, lovely as Jerusalem, awesome as an army with banners. ⁵Turn away your eyes from me, for they have overcome me. Your hair is like a flock of goats, that lie along the side of Gilead. ⁶Your teeth are like a flock of ewes, which have come up from the washing, of which every one has twins; not one is bereaved among them. ⁷Your temples are like a piece of a pomegranate behind your veil. ⁸There are sixty queens, eighty concubines, and virgins without number. ⁹My dove, my perfect one, is unique. She is her mother's only daughter. She is the favorite one of her who bore her. The daughters saw her, and called her blessed. The queens and the concubines saw her, and they praised her. ¹⁰Who is she who looks out as the morning, beautiful as the moon, clear as the sun, and awesome as an army with banners? ¹¹I went down into the nut tree grove, to see the green plants of the valley, to see whether the vine budded, and the pomegranates were in flower. ¹²Without realizing it, my desire set me with my royal people's chariots. ¹³Return, return, Shulammit! Return, return, that we may gaze at you. Lover Why do you desire to gaze at the Shulammit, as at the dance of Mahanaim?

⁷How beautiful are your feet in sandals, prince's daugh-

ter! Your rounded thighs are like jewels, the work of the hands of a skillful workman. ²Your body is like a round goblet, no mixed wine is wanting. Your waist is like a heap of wheat, set about with lilies. ³Your two breasts are like two fawns, that are twins of a roe. ⁴Your neck is like an ivory tower. Your eyes are like the pools in Heshbon by the gate of Bathrabbim. Your nose is like the tower of Lebanon which looks toward Damascus. ⁵Your head on you is like Carmel. The hair of your head like purple. The king is held captive in its tresses. ⁶How beautiful and how pleasant you are, love, for delights! ⁷This, your stature, is like a palm tree, your breasts like its fruit. ⁸I said, "I will climb up into the palm tree. I will take hold of its fruit." Let your breasts be like clusters of the vine, the smell of your breath like apples. ⁹Your mouth is like the best wine, that goes down smoothly for my beloved, gliding through the lips of those who are asleep. ¹⁰I am my beloved's. His desire is toward me. ¹¹Come, my beloved! Let's go out into the field. Let's lodge in the villages. ¹²Let's go early up to the vineyards. Let's see whether the vine has budded, its blossom is open, and the pomegranates are in flower. There I will give you my love. ¹³The mandrakes produce fragrance. At our doors are all kinds of precious fruits, new and old, which I have stored up for you, my beloved.

⁸Oh that you were like my brother, who nursed from the breasts of my mother! If I found you outside, I would kiss you; yes, and no one would despise me. ²I would lead you, bringing you into the house of my mother, who would instruct me. I would have you drink spiced wine, of the juice of my pomegranate. ³His left hand would be under my head. His right hand would embrace me. ⁴I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem, that you not stir up, nor awaken love, until it so desires. ⁵Who is this who comes up from the wilderness, leaning on her beloved? Beloved Under the apple tree I awakened you. There your mother conceived you. There she was in labor and bore you. ⁶Set me as a seal on your heart, as a seal on your arm; for love is strong as death. Jealousy is as cruel as Sheol. ⁱⁱ Its flashes are flashes of fire, a very flame of the LORD. ⁱⁱⁱ ⁷Many waters can't quench love, neither can floods drown it. If a man would give all the wealth of his house for love, he would be utterly scorned. ⁸We have a little sister. She has no breasts. What shall we do for our sister in the day when she is to be spoken for? ⁹If she is a wall, we will build on her a turret of silver. If she is a door, we will enclose her with boards of cedar. ¹⁰I am a wall, and my breasts like towers, then I was in his eyes like one who found peace. ¹¹Solomon had a vineyard at Baal Hamon. He leased out the vineyard to keepers. Each was to bring a thousand

shekels ^{iv} of silver for its fruit. ¹²My own vineyard is before me. The thousand are for you, Solomon, two hundred for those who tend its fruit. ¹³You who dwell in the gardens, with friends in attendance, let me hear your voice! ¹⁴Come away, my beloved! Be like a gazelle or a young stag on the mountains of spices!

ⁱⁱSheol is the place of the dead.

ⁱⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

^{iv}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1000 shekels is about 10 kilograms or about 22 pounds.

Isaiah

¹The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah. ²Hear, heavens, and listen, earth; for the LORD ⁱ has spoken: “I have nourished and brought up children and they have rebelled against me. ³The ox knows his owner, and the donkey his master’s crib; but Israel doesn’t know. My people don’t consider.” ⁴Ah sinful nation, a people loaded with iniquity, offspring ⁱⁱ of evildoers, children who deal corruptly! They have forsaken the LORD. They have despised the Holy One of Israel. They are estranged and backward. ⁵Why should you be beaten more, that you revolt more and more? The whole head is sick, and the whole heart faint. ⁶From the sole of the foot even to the head there is no soundness in it, but wounds, welts, and open sores. They haven’t been closed, bandaged, or soothed with oil. ⁷Your country is desolate. Your cities are burned with fire. Strangers devour your land in your presence and it is desolate, as overthrown by strangers. ⁸The daughter of Zion is left like a shelter in a vineyard, like a hut in a field of melons, like a besieged city. ⁹Unless the LORD of Hosts had left to us a very small remnant, we would have been as Sodom. We would have been like Gomorrah. ¹⁰Hear the LORD’s word, you rulers of Sodom! Listen to the law of our God, ⁱⁱⁱ you people of Gomorrah! ¹¹“What are the multitude of your sacrifices to me?”, says the LORD. “I have had enough of the burnt offerings of rams and the fat of fed animals. I don’t delight in the blood of bulls, or of lambs, or of male goats. ¹²When you come to appear before me, who has required this at your hand, to trample my courts? ¹³Bring no more vain offerings. Incense is an abomination to me. New moons, Sabbaths, and convocations—I can’t stand evil assemblies. ¹⁴My soul hates your New Moons and your appointed feasts. They are a burden to me. I am weary of bearing them. ¹⁵When you spread out your hands, I will hide my eyes from you. Yes, when you make many prayers, I will not hear. Your hands are full of blood. ¹⁶Wash yourselves. Make yourself clean. Put away the evil of your doings from before my eyes. Cease

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱor, seed

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is “ (Elohim).

to do evil. ¹⁷Learn to do well. Seek justice. Relieve the oppressed. Defend the fatherless. Plead for the widow.”

¹⁸“Come now, and let’s reason together,” says the LORD: “Though your sins are as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow. Though they are red like crimson, they shall be as wool. ¹⁹If you are willing and obedient, you will eat the good of the land; ²⁰but if you refuse and rebel, you will be devoured with the sword; for the LORD’s mouth has spoken it.” ²¹How the faithful city has become a prostitute! She was full of justice. Righteousness lodged in her, but now there are murderers. ²²Your silver has become dross, your wine mixed with water. ²³Your princes are rebellious and companions of thieves. Everyone loves bribes and follows after rewards. They don’t defend the fatherless, neither does the cause of the widow come to them. ²⁴Therefore the Lord, ^{iv} GOD of Hosts, the Mighty One of Israel, says: “Ah, I will get relief from my adversaries, and avenge myself on my enemies. ²⁵I will turn my hand on you, thoroughly purge away your dross, and will take away all your tin. ^v ²⁶I will restore your judges as at the first, and your counselors as at the beginning. Afterward you shall be called ‘The city of righteousness, a faithful town.’ ²⁷Zion shall be redeemed with justice, and her converts with righteousness. ²⁸But the destruction of transgressors and sinners shall be together, and those who forsake the LORD shall be consumed. ²⁹For they shall be ashamed of the oaks which you have desired, and you shall be confounded for the gardens that you have chosen. ³⁰For you shall be as an oak whose leaf fades, and as a garden that has no water. ³¹The strong will be like tinder, and his work like a spark. They will both burn together, and no one will quench them.”

²This is what Isaiah the son of Amoz saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem. ²It shall happen in the latter days, that the mountain of the LORD’s house shall be established on the top of the mountains, and shall be raised above the hills; and all nations shall flow to it. ³Many peoples shall go and say, “Come, let’s go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob;

^{iv}The word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

^vtin is a metal that is separated from silver during the refining and purification process.

and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths.” For the law shall go out of Zion, and the LORD’s word from Jerusalem. ⁴He will judge between the nations, and will decide concerning many peoples. They shall beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation shall not lift up sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more. ⁵House of Jacob, come, and let’s walk in the light of the LORD. ⁶For you have forsaken your people, the house of Jacob, because they are filled from the east, with those who practice divination like the Philistines, and they clasp hands with the children of foreigners. ⁷Their land is full of silver and gold, neither is there any end of their treasures. Their land also is full of horses, neither is there any end of their chariots. ⁸Their land also is full of idols. They worship the work of their own hands, that which their own fingers have made. ⁹Man is brought low, and mankind is humbled; therefore don’t forgive them. ¹⁰Enter into the rock, and hide in the dust, from before the terror of the LORD, and from the glory of his majesty. ¹¹The lofty looks of man will be brought low, the arrogance of men will be bowed down, and the LORD alone will be exalted in that day. ¹²For there will be a day of the LORD of Hosts for all that is proud and arrogant, and for all that is lifted up, and it shall be brought low—¹³for all the cedars of Lebanon, that are high and lifted up, for all the oaks of Bashan, ¹⁴for all the high mountains, for all the hills that are lifted up, ¹⁵for every lofty tower, for every fortified wall, ¹⁶for all the ships of Tarshish, and for all pleasant imagery. ¹⁷The loftiness of man shall be bowed down, and the arrogance of men shall be brought low; and the LORD alone shall be exalted in that day. ¹⁸The idols shall utterly pass away. ¹⁹Men shall go into the caves of the rocks, and into the holes of the earth, from before the terror of the LORD, and from the glory of his majesty, when he arises to shake the earth mightily. ²⁰In that day, men shall cast away their idols of silver and their idols of gold, which have been made for themselves to worship, to the moles and to the bats, ²¹to go into the caverns of the rocks, and into the clefts of the ragged rocks, from before the terror of the LORD, and from the glory of his majesty, when he arises to shake the earth mightily. ²²Stop trusting in man, whose breath is in his nostrils; for of what account is he?

³For, behold, ^{vi} the Lord, GOD of Hosts, takes away from Jerusalem and from Judah supply and support, the whole supply of bread, and the whole supply of water; ²the mighty man, the man of war, the judge, the prophet, the diviner, the elder, ³the captain of fifty, the honorable man, the counselor, the skilled craftsman, and the clever enchanter. ⁴I will give boys to be their princes, and children shall rule over them. ⁵The people will be oppressed,

everyone by another, and everyone by his neighbor. The child will behave himself proudly against the old man, and the wicked against the honorable. ⁶Indeed a man shall take hold of his brother in the house of his father, saying, “You have clothing, you be our ruler, and let this ruin be under your hand.” ⁷In that day he will cry out, saying, “I will not be a healer; for in my house is neither bread nor clothing. You shall not make me ruler of the people.” ⁸For Jerusalem is ruined, and Judah is fallen; because their tongue and their doings are against the LORD, to provoke the eyes of his glory. ⁹The look of their faces testify against them. They parade their sin like Sodom. They don’t hide it. Woe to their soul! For they have brought disaster upon themselves. ¹⁰Tell the righteous that it will be well with them, for they will eat the fruit of their deeds. ¹¹Woe to the wicked! Disaster is upon them, for the deeds of their hands will be paid back to them. ¹²As for my people, children are their oppressors, and women rule over them. My people, those who lead you cause you to err, and destroy the way of your paths. ¹³The LORD stands up to contend, and stands to judge the peoples. ¹⁴The LORD will enter into judgment with the elders of his people and their leaders: “It is you who have eaten up the vineyard. The plunder of the poor is in your houses. ¹⁵What do you mean that you crush my people, and grind the face of the poor?” says the Lord, the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁶Moreover the LORD said, “Because the daughters of Zion are arrogant, and walk with outstretched necks and flirting eyes, walking daintily as they go, jingling ornaments on their feet; ¹⁷therefore the Lord brings sores on the crown of the head of the women of Zion, and the LORD will make their scalps bald.” ¹⁸In that day the Lord will take away the beauty of their anklets, the headbands, the crescent necklaces, ¹⁹the earrings, the bracelets, the veils, ²⁰the headdresses, the ankle chains, the sashes, the perfume containers, the charms, ²¹the signet rings, the nose rings, ²²the fine robes, the capes, the cloaks, the purses, ²³the hand mirrors, the fine linen garments, the tiaras, and the shawls. ²⁴It shall happen that instead of sweet spices, there shall be rottenness; instead of a belt, a rope; instead of well set hair, baldness; instead of a robe, a wearing of sackcloth; and branding instead of beauty. ²⁵Your men shall fall by the sword, and your mighty in the war. ²⁶Her gates shall lament and mourn. She shall be desolate and sit on the ground.

⁴Seven women shall take hold of one man in that day, saying, “We will eat our own bread, and wear our own clothing. Just let us be called by your name. Take away our reproach.” ²In that day, the LORD’s branch will be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the land will be the beauty and glory of the survivors of Israel. ³It will happen that he who is left in Zion and he who remains in Jerusalem shall be called holy, even everyone who is written among the living in Jerusalem, ⁴when the Lord

^{vi}“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

shall have washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion, and shall have purged the blood of Jerusalem from within it, by the spirit of justice and by the spirit of burning. ⁵The LORD will create over the whole habitation of Mount Zion and over her assemblies, a cloud and smoke by day, and the shining of a flaming fire by night, for over all the glory will be a canopy. ⁶There will be a pavilion for a shade in the daytime from the heat, and for a refuge and for a shelter from storm and from rain.

⁵Let me sing for my well beloved a song of my beloved about his vineyard. My beloved had a vineyard on a very fruitful hill. ²He dug it up, gathered out its stones, planted it with the choicest vine, built a tower in the middle of it, and also cut out a wine press in it. He looked for it to yield grapes, but it yielded wild grapes. ³“Now, inhabitants of Jerusalem and men of Judah, please judge between me and my vineyard. ⁴What could have been done more to my vineyard, that I have not done in it? Why, when I looked for it to yield grapes, did it yield wild grapes? ⁵Now I will tell you what I will do to my vineyard. I will take away its hedge, and it will be eaten up. I will break down its wall, and it will be trampled down. ⁶I will lay it a wasteland. It won’t be pruned or hoed, but it will grow briars and thorns. I will also command the clouds that they rain no rain on it.” ⁷For the vineyard of the LORD of Hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah his pleasant plant. He looked for justice, but behold, oppression, for righteousness, but behold, a cry of distress. ⁸Woe to those who join house to house, who lay field to field, until there is no room, and you are made to dwell alone in the middle of the land! ⁹In my ears, the LORD of Hosts says: “Surely many houses will be desolate, even great and beautiful, unoccupied. ¹⁰For ten acres ^{vii} of vineyard shall yield one bath, ^{viii} and a homer ^{ix} of seed shall yield an ephah.” ^x ¹¹Woe to those who rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink, who stay late into the night, until wine inflames them! ¹²The harp, lyre, tambourine, and flute, with wine, are at their feasts; but they don’t respect the work of the LORD, neither have they considered the operation of his hands. ¹³Therefore my people go into captivity for lack of knowledge. Their honorable men are famished, and their multitudes are parched with thirst. ¹⁴Therefore Sheol ^{xi} has enlarged its desire, and opened its mouth without measure; and their glory, their multitude, their pomp, and he who rejoices among them, descend into it. ¹⁵So man is brought low, mankind is humbled, and the eyes of the arrogant ones are humbled; ¹⁶but

the LORD of Hosts is exalted in justice, and God the Holy One is sanctified in righteousness. ¹⁷Then the lambs will graze as in their pasture, and strangers will eat the ruins of the rich. ¹⁸Woe to those who draw iniquity with cords of falsehood, and wickedness as with cart rope, ¹⁹who say, “Let him make haste, let him hasten his work, that we may see it; let the counsel of the Holy One of Israel draw near and come, that we may know it!” ²⁰Woe to those who call evil good, and good evil; who put darkness for light, and light for darkness; who put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter! ²¹Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight! ²²Woe to those who are mighty to drink wine, and champions at mixing strong drink; ²³who acquit the guilty for a bribe, but deny justice for the innocent! ²⁴Therefore as the tongue of fire devours the stubble, and as the dry grass sinks down in the flame, so their root shall be as rottenness, and their blossom shall go up as dust, because they have rejected the law of the LORD of Hosts, and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel. ²⁵Therefore the LORD’s anger burns against his people, and he has stretched out his hand against them and has struck them. The mountains tremble, and their dead bodies are as refuse in the middle of the streets. For all this, his anger is not turned away, but his hand is still stretched out. ²⁶He will lift up a banner to the nations from far away, and he will whistle for them from the end of the earth. Behold, they will come speedily and swiftly. ²⁷No one shall be weary nor stumble among them; no one shall slumber nor sleep, neither shall the belt of their waist be untied, nor the strap of their sandals be broken, ²⁸whose arrows are sharp, and all their bows bent. Their horses’ hoofs will be like flint, and their wheels like a whirlwind. ²⁹Their roaring will be like a lioness. They will roar like young lions. Yes, they shall roar, and seize their prey and carry it off, and there will be no one to deliver. ³⁰They will roar against them in that day like the roaring of the sea. If one looks to the land, behold, darkness and distress. The light is darkened in its clouds.

⁶In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up; and his train filled the temple. ²Above him stood the seraphim. Each one had six wings. With two he covered his face. With two he covered his feet. With two he flew. ³One called to another, and said, “Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of Hosts! The whole earth is full of his glory!” ⁴The foundations of the thresholds shook at the voice of him who called, and the house was filled with smoke. ⁵Then I said, “Woe is me! For I am undone, because I am a man of unclean lips and I live among a people of unclean lips, for my eyes have seen the King, the LORD of Hosts!” ⁶Then one of the seraphim flew to me, having a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with the tongs from off the altar. ⁷He touched my mouth with it, and said, “Behold, this has touched

^{vii}literally, ten yokes, or the amount of land that ten yokes of oxen can plow in one day, which is about 10 acres or 4 hectares.

^{viii}1 bath is about 22 liters or 5.8 U. S. gallons

^{ix}1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

^x1 ephah is about 22 liters or 0.6 bushels or about 2 pecks—only one tenth of what was sown.

^{xi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

your lips; and your iniquity is taken away, and your sin forgiven.” ⁸I heard the Lord’s voice, saying, “Whom shall I send, and who will go for us?” Then I said, “Here I am. Send me!” ⁹He said, “Go, and tell this people, ‘You hear indeed, but don’t understand. You see indeed, but don’t perceive.’” ¹⁰Make the heart of this people fat. Make their ears heavy, and shut their eyes; lest they see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their heart, and turn again, and be healed.” ¹¹Then I said, “Lord, how long?” He answered, “Until cities are waste without inhabitant, houses without man, the land becomes utterly waste, ¹²and the LORD has removed men far away, and the forsaken places are many within the land. ¹³If there is a tenth left in it, that also will in turn be consumed, as a terebinth, and as an oak whose stump remains when they are cut down, so the holy seed is its stump.”

⁷In the days of Ahaz the son of Jotham, the son of Uzziah, king of Judah, Rezin the king of Syria and Pekah the son of Remaliah, king of Israel, went up to Jerusalem to war against it, but could not prevail against it. ²David’s house was told, “Syria is allied with Ephraim.” His heart trembled, and the heart of his people, as the trees of the forest tremble with the wind. ³Then the LORD said to Isaiah, “Go out now to meet Ahaz, you, and Shearjashub your son, at the end of the conduit of the upper pool, on the highway of the fuller’s field. ⁴Tell him, ‘Be careful, and keep calm. Don’t be afraid, neither let your heart be faint because of these two tails of smoking torches, for the fierce anger of Rezin and Syria, and of the son of Remaliah. ⁵Because Syria, Ephraim, and the son of Remaliah, have plotted evil against you, saying, ⁶“Let’s go up against Judah, and tear it apart, and let’s divide it among ourselves, and set up a king within it, even the son of Tabeel.” ⁷This is what the Lord GOD says: “It shall not stand, neither shall it happen.” ⁸For the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rezin. Within sixty-five years Ephraim shall be broken in pieces, so that it shall not be a people. ⁹The head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is Remaliah’s son. If you will not believe, surely you shall not be established.’” ¹⁰The LORD spoke again to Ahaz, saying, ¹¹“Ask a sign of the LORD your God; ask it either in the depth, or in the height above.” ¹²But Ahaz said, “I won’t ask. I won’t tempt the LORD.” ¹³He said, “Listen now, house of David. Is it not enough for you to try the patience of men, that you will try the patience of my God also? ¹⁴Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign. Behold, the virgin will conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel. ^{xii} ¹⁵He shall eat butter and honey when he knows to refuse the evil and choose the good. ¹⁶For before the child knows to refuse the evil and choose the good, the land whose two kings you abhor shall be forsaken. ¹⁷The LORD will bring on

you, on your people, and on your father’s house days that have not come, from the day that Ephraim departed from Judah, even the king of Assyria. ¹⁸It will happen in that day that the LORD will whistle for the fly that is in the uttermost part of the rivers of Egypt, and for the bee that is in the land of Assyria. ¹⁹They shall come, and shall all rest in the desolate valleys, in the clefts of the rocks, on all thorn hedges, and on all pastures. ²⁰In that day the Lord will shave with a razor that is hired in the parts beyond the River, even with the king of Assyria, the head and the hair of the feet; and it shall also consume the beard. ²¹It shall happen in that day that a man shall keep alive a young cow, and two sheep. ²²It shall happen, that because of the abundance of milk which they shall give he shall eat butter, for everyone will eat butter and honey that is left within the land. ²³It will happen in that day that every place where there were a thousand vines worth a thousand silver shekels, ^{xiii} will be for briers and thorns. ²⁴People will go there with arrows and with bow, because all the land will be briers and thorns. ²⁵All the hills that were cultivated with the hoe, you shall not come there for fear of briers and thorns; but it shall be for the sending out of oxen, and for sheep to tread on.”

⁸The LORD said to me, “Take a large tablet, and write on it with a man’s pen, ‘For Maher Shalal Hash Baz’; ^{xiv} ²and I will take for myself faithful witnesses to testify: Uriah the priest, and Zechariah the son of Jeberechiah.” ³I went to the prophetess, and she conceived, and bore a son. Then the LORD said to me, “Call his name ‘Maher Shalal Hash Baz.’” ⁴For before the child knows how to say, ‘My father’ and ‘My mother,’ the riches of Damascus and the plunder of Samaria will be carried away by the king of Assyria.” ⁵The LORD spoke to me yet again, saying, ⁶“Because this people has refused the waters of Shiloah that go softly, and rejoice in Rezin and Remaliah’s son; ⁷now therefore, behold, the Lord brings upon them the mighty flood waters of the River: the king of Assyria and all his glory. It will come up over all its channels, and go over all its banks. ⁸It will sweep onward into Judah. It will overflow and pass through. It will reach even to the neck. The stretching out of its wings will fill the width of your land, O Immanuel. ⁹Make an uproar, you peoples, and be broken in pieces! Listen, all you from far countries: dress for battle, and be shattered! Dress for battle, and be shattered! ¹⁰Take counsel together, and it will be brought to nothing; speak the word, and it will not stand, for God is with us.” ¹¹For the LORD spoke this to me with a strong hand, and instructed me not to walk in the way of this people, saying, ¹²“Don’t call a conspiracy all

^{xiii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1000 shekels is about 10 kilograms or 22 pounds.

^{xiv}“Maher Shalal Hash Baz” means “quick to the plunder, swift to the prey”.

^{xii}“Immanuel” means “God with us”.

that this people call a conspiracy. Don't fear their threats or be terrorized. ¹³The LORD of Hosts is who you must respect as holy. He is the one you must fear. He is the one you must dread. ¹⁴He will be a sanctuary, but for both houses of Israel, he will be a stumbling stone and a rock that makes them fall. For the people of Jerusalem, he will be a trap and a snare. ¹⁵Many will stumble over it, fall, be broken, be snared, and be captured." ¹⁶Wrap up the covenant. Seal the law among my disciples. ¹⁷I will wait for the LORD, who hides his face from the house of Jacob, and I will look for him. ¹⁸Behold, I and the children whom the LORD has given me are for signs and for wonders in Israel from the LORD of Hosts, who dwells in Mount Zion. ¹⁹When they tell you, "Consult with those who have familiar spirits and with the wizards, who chirp and who mutter," shouldn't a people consult with their God? Should they consult the dead on behalf of the living? ²⁰Turn to the law and to the covenant! If they don't speak according to this word, surely there is no morning for them. ²¹They will pass through it, very distressed and hungry. It will happen that when they are hungry, they will worry, and curse their king and their God. They will turn their faces upward, ²²then look to the earth and see distress, darkness, and the gloom of anguish. They will be driven into thick darkness.

9But there shall be no more gloom for her who was in anguish. In the former time, he brought into contempt the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali; but in the latter time he has made it glorious, by the way of the sea, beyond the Jordan, Galilee of the nations. ²The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light. The light has shined on those who lived in the land of the shadow of death. ³You have multiplied the nation. You have increased their joy. They rejoice before you according to the joy in harvest, as men rejoice when they divide the plunder. ⁴For the yoke of his burden, and the staff of his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, you have broken as in the day of Midian. ⁵For all the armor of the armed man in the noisy battle, and the garments rolled in blood, will be for burning, fuel for the fire. ⁶For a child is born to us. A son is given to us; and the government will be on his shoulders. His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. ⁷Of the increase of his government and of peace there shall be no end, on David's throne, and on his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from that time on, even forever. The zeal of the LORD of Hosts will perform this. ⁸The Lord sent a word into Jacob, and it falls on Israel. ⁹All the people will know, including Ephraim and the inhabitants of Samaria, who say in pride and in arrogance of heart, ¹⁰"The bricks have fallen, but we will build with cut stone. The sycamore fig trees have been cut down, but we will put cedars in their place."

¹¹Therefore the LORD will set up on high against him the adversaries of Rezin, and will stir up his enemies, ¹²The Syrians in front, and the Philistines behind; and they will devour Israel with open mouth. For all this, his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still. ¹³Yet the people have not turned to him who struck them, neither have they sought the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁴Therefore the LORD will cut off from Israel head and tail, palm branch and reed, in one day. ¹⁵The elder and the honorable man is the head, and the prophet who teaches lies is the tail. ¹⁶For those who lead this people lead them astray; and those who are led by them are destroyed. ¹⁷Therefore the Lord will not rejoice over their young men, neither will he have compassion on their fatherless and widows; for everyone is profane and an evildoer, and every mouth speaks folly. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still. ¹⁸For wickedness burns like a fire. It devours the briars and thorns; yes, it kindles in the thickets of the forest, and they roll upward in a column of smoke. ¹⁹Through the LORD of Hosts' wrath, the land is burned up; and the people are the fuel for the fire. No one spares his brother. ²⁰One will devour on the right hand, and be hungry; and he will eat on the left hand, and they will not be satisfied. Everyone will eat the flesh of his own arm: ²¹Manasseh eating Ephraim and Ephraim eating Manasseh, and they together will be against Judah. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still.

10Woe to those who decree unrighteous decrees, and to the writers who write oppressive decrees ²to deprive the needy of justice, and to rob the poor among my people of their rights, that widows may be their plunder, and that they may make the fatherless their prey! ³What will you do in the day of visitation, and in the desolation which will come from afar? To whom will you flee for help? Where will you leave your wealth? ⁴They will only bow down under the prisoners, and will fall under the slain. For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still. ⁵Alas Assyrian, the rod of my anger, the staff in whose hand is my indignation! ⁶I will send him against a profane nation, and against the people who anger me I will give him a command to take the plunder and to take the prey, and to tread them down like the mire of the streets. ⁷However, he doesn't mean so, neither does his heart think so; but it is in his heart to destroy, and to cut off not a few nations. ⁸For he says, "Aren't all of my princes kings? ⁹Isn't Calno like Carchemish? Isn't Hamath like Arpad? Isn't Samaria like Damascus?" ¹⁰As my hand has found the kingdoms of the idols, whose engraved images exceeded those of Jerusalem and of Samaria, ¹¹shall I not, as I have done to Samaria and her idols, so do to Jerusalem and her idols? ¹²Therefore it will happen that when the Lord has performed his whole work on

Mount Zion and on Jerusalem, I will punish the fruit of the willful proud heart of the king of Assyria, and the insolence of his arrogant looks. ¹³For he has said, "By the strength of my hand I have done it, and by my wisdom, for I have understanding. I have removed the boundaries of the peoples, and have robbed their treasures. Like a valiant man I have brought down their rulers. ¹⁴My hand has found the riches of the peoples like a nest, and like one gathers eggs that are abandoned, I have gathered all the earth. There was no one who moved their wing, or that opened their mouth, or chirped." ¹⁵Should an ax brag against him who chops with it? Should a saw exalt itself above him who saws with it? As if a rod should lift those who lift it up, or as if a staff should lift up someone who is not wood. ¹⁶Therefore the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, will send among his fat ones leanness; and under his glory a burning will be kindled like the burning of fire. ¹⁷The light of Israel will be for a fire, and his Holy One for a flame; and it will burn and devour his thorns and his briers in one day. ¹⁸He will consume the glory of his forest and of his fruitful field, both soul and body. It will be as when a standard bearer faints. ¹⁹The remnant of the trees of his forest shall be few, so that a child could write their number. ²⁰It will come to pass in that day that the remnant of Israel, and those who have escaped from the house of Jacob will no more again lean on him who struck them, but shall lean on the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, in truth. ²¹A remnant will return, even the remnant of Jacob, to the mighty God. ²²For though your people, Israel, are like the sand of the sea, only a remnant of them will return. A destruction is determined, overflowing with righteousness. ²³For the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, will make a full end, and that determined, throughout all the earth. ²⁴Therefore the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, says, "My people who dwell in Zion, don't be afraid of the Assyrian, though he strike you with the rod, and lift up his staff against you, as Egypt did. ²⁵For yet a very little while, and the indignation against you will be accomplished, and my anger will be directed to his destruction." ²⁶The LORD of Hosts will stir up a scourge against him, as in the slaughter of Midian at the rock of Oreb. His rod will be over the sea, and he will lift it up like he did against Egypt. ²⁷It will happen in that day that his burden will depart from off your shoulder, and his yoke from off your neck, and the yoke shall be destroyed because of the anointing oil. ²⁸He has come to Aiath. He has passed through Migron. At Michmash he stores his baggage. ²⁹They have gone over the pass. They have taken up their lodging at Geba. Ramah trembles. Gibeah of Saul has fled. ³⁰Cry aloud with your voice, daughter of Gallim! Listen, Laishah! You poor Anathoth! ³¹Madmenah is a fugitive. The inhabitants of Gebim flee for safety. ³²This very day he will halt at Nob. He shakes his hand at the mountain of the daughter of Zion, the hill of Jerusalem. ³³Behold, the Lord, the LORD of Hosts,

will lop the boughs with terror. The tall will be cut down, and the lofty will be brought low. ³⁴He will cut down the thickets of the forest with iron, and Lebanon will fall by the Mighty One.

11 ¹A shoot will come out of the stock of Jesse, and a branch out of his roots will bear fruit. ²The LORD's Spirit will rest on him: the spirit of wisdom and understanding, the spirit of counsel and might, the spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD. ³His delight will be in the fear of the LORD. He will not judge by the sight of his eyes, neither decide by the hearing of his ears; ⁴but he will judge the poor with righteousness, and decide with equity for the humble of the earth. He will strike the earth with the rod of his mouth; and with the breath of his lips he will kill the wicked. ⁵Righteousness will be the belt around his waist, and faithfulness the belt around his waist. ⁶The wolf will live with the lamb, and the leopard will lie down with the young goat, the calf, the young lion, and the fattened calf together; and a little child will lead them. ⁷The cow and the bear will graze. Their young ones will lie down together. The lion will eat straw like the ox. ⁸The nursing child will play near a cobra's hole, and the weaned child will put his hand on the viper's den. ⁹They will not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain; for the earth will be full of the knowledge of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea. ¹⁰It will happen in that day that the nations will seek the root of Jesse, who stands as a banner of the peoples; and his resting place will be glorious. ¹¹It will happen in that day that the Lord will set his hand again the second time to recover the remnant that is left of his people from Assyria, from Egypt, from Pathros, from Cush, from Elam, from Shinar, from Hamath, and from the islands of the sea. ¹²He will set up a banner for the nations, and will assemble the outcasts of Israel, and gather together the dispersed of Judah from the four corners of the earth. ¹³The envy also of Ephraim will depart, and those who persecute Judah will be cut off. Ephraim won't envy Judah, and Judah won't persecute Ephraim. ¹⁴They will fly down on the shoulders of the Philistines on the west. Together they will plunder the children of the east. They will extend their power over Edom and Moab, and the children of Ammon will obey them. ¹⁵The LORD will utterly destroy the tongue of the Egyptian sea; and with his scorching wind he will wave his hand over the River, and will split it into seven streams, and cause men to march over in sandals. ¹⁶There will be a highway for the remnant that is left of his people from Assyria, like there was for Israel in the day that he came up out of the land of Egypt.

12 ¹In that day you will say, "I will give thanks to you, the LORD; for though you were angry with me, your anger has turned away and you comfort me. ²Behold, God is

my salvation. I will trust, and will not be afraid; for the LORD, the LORD, is my strength and song; and he has become my salvation [yeshu'ah].³ Therefore with joy you will draw water out of the wells of salvation [yeshu'ah].⁴ In that day you will say, "Give thanks to the LORD! Call on his name! Declare his doings among the peoples! Proclaim that his name is exalted!"⁵ Sing to the LORD, for he has done excellent things! Let this be known in all the earth!⁶ Cry aloud and shout, you inhabitant of Zion, for the Holy One of Israel is great among you!"

13 The burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz saw.² Set up a banner on the bare mountain! Lift up your voice to them! Wave your hand, that they may go into the gates of the nobles.³ I have commanded my consecrated ones; yes, I have called my mighty men for my anger, even my proudly exulting ones.⁴ The noise of a multitude is in the mountains, as of a great people; the noise of an uproar of the kingdoms of the nations gathered together! The LORD of Hosts is mustering the army for the battle.⁵ They come from a far country, from the uttermost part of heaven, even the LORD, and the weapons of his indignation, to destroy the whole land.⁶ Wail, for the LORD's day is at hand! It will come as destruction from the Almighty.⁷ Therefore all hands will be feeble, and everyone's heart will melt.⁸ They will be dismayed. Pangs and sorrows will seize them. They will be in pain like a woman in labor. They will look in amazement one at another. Their faces will be faces of flame.⁹ Behold, the day of the LORD comes, cruel, with wrath and fierce anger; to make the land a desolation, and to destroy its sinners out of it.¹⁰ For the stars of the sky and its constellations will not give their light. The sun will be darkened in its going out, and the moon will not cause its light to shine.¹¹ I will punish the world for their evil, and the wicked for their iniquity. I will cause the arrogance of the proud to cease, and will humble the arrogance of the terrible.¹² I will make people more rare than fine gold, even a person than the pure gold of Ophir.¹³ Therefore I will make the heavens tremble, and the earth will be shaken out of its place in the LORD of Hosts' wrath, and in the day of his fierce anger.¹⁴ It will happen that like a hunted gazelle and like sheep that no one gathers, they will each turn to their own people, and will each flee to their own land.¹⁵ Everyone who is found will be thrust through. Everyone who is captured will fall by the sword.¹⁶ Their infants also will be dashed in pieces before their eyes. Their houses will be ransacked, and their wives raped.¹⁷ Behold, I will stir up the Medes against them, who will not value silver, and as for gold, they will not delight in it.¹⁸ Their bows will dash the young men in pieces; and they shall have no pity on the fruit of the womb. Their eyes will not spare children.¹⁹ Babylon, the glory of kingdoms, the beauty of the Kasdim' pride, will be like when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah.²⁰ It

will never be inhabited, neither will it be lived in from generation to generation. The Arabian will not pitch a tent there, neither will shepherds make their flocks lie down there.²¹ But wild animals of the desert will lie there, and their houses will be full of jackals. Ostriches will dwell there, and wild goats will frolic there.²² Hyenas will cry in their fortresses, and jackals in the pleasant palaces. Her time is near to come, and her days will not be prolonged.

14 For the LORD will have compassion on Jacob, and will yet choose Israel, and set them in their own land. The foreigner will join himself with them, and they will unite with the house of Jacob.² The peoples will take them, and bring them to their place. The house of Israel will possess them in the LORD's land for servants and for handmaids. They will take as captives those whose captives they were; and they shall rule over their oppressors.³ It will happen in the day that the LORD will give you rest from your sorrow, from your trouble, and from the hard service in which you were made to serve,⁴ that you will take up this parable against the king of Babylon, and say, "How the oppressor has ceased! The golden city has ceased!"⁵ The LORD has broken the staff of the wicked, the scepter of the rulers,⁶ who struck the peoples in wrath with a continual stroke, who ruled the nations in anger, with a persecution that no one restrained.⁷ The whole earth is at rest, and is quiet. They break out in song.⁸ Yes, the cypress trees rejoice with you, with the cedars of Lebanon, saying, "Since you are humbled, no lumberjack has come up against us."⁹ Sheol^{xv} from beneath has moved for you to meet you at your coming. It stirs up the departed spirits for you, even all the rulers of the earth. It has raised up from their thrones all the kings of the nations.¹⁰ They all will answer and ask you, "Have you also become as weak as we are? Have you become like us?"¹¹ Your pomp is brought down to Sheol,^{xvi} with the sound of your stringed instruments. Maggots are spread out under you, and worms cover you.¹² How you have fallen from heaven, shining one, son of the dawn! How you are cut down to the ground, who laid the nations low!¹³ You said in your heart, "I will ascend into heaven! I will exalt my throne above the stars of God! I will sit on the mountain of assembly, in the far north!"¹⁴ I will ascend above the heights of the clouds! I will make myself like the Most High!"¹⁵ Yet you shall be brought down to Sheol,^{xvii} to the depths of the pit.¹⁶ Those who see you will stare at you. They will ponder you, saying, "Is this the man who made the earth to tremble, who shook kingdoms,¹⁷ who made the world like a wilderness, and overthrew its cities, who didn't release his prisoners to their home?"¹⁸ All the kings of the nations sleep in glory, everyone in his own house.¹⁹ But you are cast away from your tomb like an

^{xv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xvi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xvii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

abominable branch, clothed with the slain who are thrust through with the sword, who go down to the stones of the pit; like a dead body trodden under foot. ²⁰You will not join them in burial, because you have destroyed your land. You have killed your people. The offspring of evildoers will not be named forever. ²¹Prepare for slaughter of his children because of the iniquity of their fathers, that they not rise up and possess the earth, and fill the surface of the world with cities. ²²"I will rise up against them," says the LORD of Hosts, "and cut off from Babylon name and remnant, and son and son's son," says the LORD. ²³"I will also make it a possession for the porcupine, and pools of water. I will sweep it with the broom of destruction," says the LORD of Hosts. ²⁴The LORD of Hosts has sworn, saying, "Surely, as I have thought, so shall it happen; and as I have purposed, so shall it stand: ²⁵that I will break the Assyrian in my land, and tread him under foot on my mountains. Then his yoke will leave them, and his burden leave their shoulders. ²⁶This is the plan that is determined for the whole earth. This is the hand that is stretched out over all the nations. ²⁷For the LORD of Hosts has planned, and who can stop it? His hand is stretched out, and who can turn it back?" ²⁸This burden was in the year that King Ahaz died. ²⁹Don't rejoice, O Philistia, all of you, because the rod that struck you is broken; for out of the serpent's root an adder will emerge, and his fruit will be a fiery flying serpent. ³⁰The firstborn of the poor will eat, and the needy will lie down in safety; and I will kill your root with famine, and your remnant will be killed. ³¹Howl, gate! Cry, city! You are melted away, Philistia, all of you; for smoke comes out of the north, and there is no straggler in his ranks. ³²What will they answer the messengers of the nation? That the LORD has founded Zion, and in her the afflicted of his people will take refuge.

15The burden of Moab. For in a night, Ar of Moab is laid waste, and brought to nothing. For in a night Kir of Moab is laid waste, and brought to nothing. ²They have gone up to Bayith, and to Dibon, to the high places, to weep. Moab wails over Nebo and over Medeba. Baldness is on all of their heads. Every beard is cut off. ³In their streets, they clothe themselves in sackcloth. In their streets and on their housetops, everyone wails, weeping abundantly. ⁴Heshbon cries out with Elealeh. Their voice is heard even to Jahaz. Therefore the armed men of Moab cry aloud. Their souls tremble within them. ⁵My heart cries out for Moab! Her Nazirites flee to Zoar, to Eglath Shelishiyah; for they go up by the ascent of Luhith with weeping; for on the way to Horonaim, they raise up a cry of destruction. ⁶For the waters of Nimrim will be desolate; for the grass has withered away, the tender grass fails, there is no green thing. ⁷Therefore they will carry away the abundance they have gotten, and that which they have stored up, over the brook of the willows. ⁸For the cry has

gone around the borders of Moab, its wailing to Eglaim, and its wailing to Beer Elim. ⁹For the waters of Dimon are full of blood; for I will bring yet more on Dimon, a lion on those of Moab who escape, and on the remnant of the land.

16Send the lambs for the ruler of the land from Selah to the wilderness, to the mountain of the daughter of Zion. ²For it will be that as wandering birds, as a scattered nest, so will the daughters of Moab be at the fords of the Arnon. ³Give counsel! Execute justice! Make your shade like the night in the middle of the noonday! Hide the outcasts! Don't betray the fugitive! ⁴Let my outcasts dwell with you! As for Moab, be a hiding place for him from the face of the destroyer. For the extortionist is brought to nothing. Destruction ceases. The oppressors are consumed out of the land. ⁵A throne will be established in loving kindness. One will sit on it in truth, in the tent of David, judging, seeking justice, and swift to do righteousness. ⁶We have heard of the pride of Moab, that he is very proud; even of his arrogance, his pride, and his wrath. His boastings are nothing. ⁷Therefore Moab will wail for Moab. Everyone will wail. You will mourn for the raisin cakes of Kir Hareseth, utterly stricken. ⁸For the fields of Heshbon languish with the vine of Sibmah. The lords of the nations have broken down its choice branches, which reached even to Jazer, which wandered into the wilderness. Its shoots were spread abroad. They passed over the sea. ⁹Therefore I will weep with the weeping of Jazer for the vine of Sibmah. I will water you with my tears, Heshbon, and Elealeh: for on your summer fruits and on your harvest the battle shout has fallen. ¹⁰Gladness is taken away, and joy out of the fruitful field; and in the vineyards there will be no singing, neither joyful noise. Nobody will tread out wine in the presses. I have made the shouting stop. ¹¹Therefore my heart sounds like a harp for Moab, and my inward parts for Kir Heres. ¹²It will happen that when Moab presents himself, when he wearies himself on the high place, and comes to his sanctuary to pray, that he will not prevail. ¹³This is the word that the LORD spoke concerning Moab in time past. ¹⁴But now the LORD has spoken, saying, "Within three years, as a worker bound by contract would count them, the glory of Moab shall be brought into contempt, with all his great multitude; and the remnant will be very small and feeble."

17The burden of Damascus. "Behold, Damascus is taken away from being a city, and it will be a ruinous heap. ²The cities of Aroer are forsaken. They will be for flocks, which shall lie down, and no one shall make them afraid. ³The fortress shall cease from Ephraim, and the kingdom from Damascus, and the remnant of Syria. They will be as the glory of the children of Israel," says the LORD of Hosts. ⁴"It will happen in that day that the glory of Jacob

will be made thin, and the fatness of his flesh will become lean. ⁵It will be like when the harvester gathers the wheat, and his arm reaps the grain. Yes, it will be like when one gleanings grain in the valley of Rephaim. ⁶Yet gleanings will be left there, like the shaking of an olive tree, two or three olives in the top of the uppermost bough, four or five in the outermost branches of a fruitful tree," says the LORD, the God of Israel. ⁷In that day, people will look to their Maker, and their eyes will have respect for the Holy One of Israel. ⁸They will not look to the altars, the work of their hands; neither shall they respect that which their fingers have made, either the Asherah poles or the incense altars. ⁹In that day, their strong cities will be like the forsaken places in the woods and on the mountain top, which were forsaken from before the children of Israel; and it will be a desolation. ¹⁰For you have forgotten the God of your salvation, and have not remembered the rock of your strength. Therefore you plant pleasant plants, and set out foreign seedlings. ¹¹In the day of your planting, you hedge it in. In the morning, you make your seed blossom, but the harvest flees away in the day of grief and of desperate sorrow. ¹²Ah, the uproar of many peoples who roar like the roaring of the seas; and the rushing of nations that rush like the rushing of mighty waters! ¹³The nations will rush like the rushing of many waters, but he will rebuke them, and they will flee far off, and will be chased like the chaff of the mountains before the wind, and like the whirling dust before the storm. ¹⁴At evening, behold, terror! Before the morning, they are no more. This is the portion of those who plunder us, and the lot of those who rob us.

¹⁸Ah, the land of the rustling of wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia; ²that sends ambassadors by the sea, even in vessels of papyrus on the waters, saying, "Go, you swift messengers, to a nation tall and smooth, to a people awesome from their beginning onward, a nation that measures out and treads down, whose land the rivers divide!" ³All you inhabitants of the world, and you dwellers on the earth, when a banner is lifted up on the mountains, look! When the shofar is blown, listen! ⁴For the LORD said to me, "I will be still, and I will see in my dwelling place, like clear heat in sunshine, like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest." ⁵For before the harvest, when the blossom is over, and the flower becomes a ripening grape, he will cut off the sprigs with pruning hooks, and he will cut down and take away the spreading branches. ⁶They will be left together for the ravenous birds of the mountains, and for the animals of the earth. The ravenous birds will eat them in the summer, and all the animals of the earth will eat them in the winter. ⁷In that time, a present will be brought to the LORD of Hosts from a people tall and smooth, even from a people awesome from their beginning onward, a nation that measures out and treads down, whose land the rivers divide, to the place of the name of the LORD of Hosts,

Mount Zion.

¹⁹The burden of Egypt. "Behold, the LORD rides on a swift cloud, and comes to Egypt. The idols of Egypt will tremble at his presence; and the heart of Egypt will melt within it. ²I will stir up the Egyptians against the Egyptians, and they will fight everyone against his brother, and everyone against his neighbor; city against city, and kingdom against kingdom. ³The spirit of the Egyptians will fail within them. I will destroy their counsel. They will seek the idols, the charmers, those who have familiar spirits, and the wizards. ⁴I will give over the Egyptians into the hand of a cruel lord. A fierce king will rule over them," says the Lord, the LORD of Hosts. ⁵The waters will fail from the sea, and the river will be wasted and become dry. ⁶The rivers will become foul. The streams of Egypt will be diminished and dried up. The reeds and flags will wither away. ⁷The meadows by the Nile, by the brink of the Nile, and all the sown fields of the Nile, will become dry, be driven away, and be no more. ⁸The fishermen will lament, and all those who fish in the Nile will mourn, and those who spread nets on the waters will languish. ⁹Moreover those who work in combed flax, and those who weave white cloth, will be confounded. ¹⁰The pillars will be broken in pieces. All those who work for hire will be grieved in soul. ¹¹The princes of Zoan are utterly foolish. The counsel of the wisest counselors of Pharaoh has become stupid. How do you say to Pharaoh, "I am the son of the wise, the son of ancient kings?" ¹²Where then are your wise men? Let them tell you now; and let them know what the LORD of Hosts has purposed concerning Egypt. ¹³The princes of Zoan have become fools. The princes of Memphis are deceived. They have caused Egypt to go astray, those who are the cornerstone of her tribes. ¹⁴The LORD has mixed a spirit of perverseness in the middle of her; and they have caused Egypt to go astray in all of its works, like a drunken man staggers in his vomit. ¹⁵Neither shall there be any work for Egypt, which head or tail, palm branch or rush, may do. ¹⁶In that day the Egyptians will be like women. They will tremble and fear because of the shaking of the LORD of Hosts's hand, which he shakes over them. ¹⁷The land of Judah will become a terror to Egypt. Everyone to whom mention is made of it will be afraid, because of the plans of the LORD of Hosts, which he determines against it. ¹⁸In that day, there will be five cities in the land of Egypt that speak the language of Canaan, and swear to the LORD of Hosts. One will be called "The city of destruction." ¹⁹In that day, there will be an altar to the LORD in the middle of the land of Egypt, and a pillar to the LORD at its border. ²⁰It will be for a sign and for a witness to the LORD of Hosts in the land of Egypt; for they will cry to the LORD because of oppressors, and he will send them a savior and a defender, and he will deliver them. ²¹The LORD will be

known to Egypt, and the Egyptians will know the LORD in that day. Yes, they will worship with sacrifice and offering, and will vow a vow to the LORD, and will perform it. ²²The LORD will strike Egypt, striking and healing. They will return to the LORD, and he will be entreated by them, and will heal them. ²³In that day there will be a highway out of Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria; and the Egyptians will worship with the Assyrians. ²⁴In that day, Israel will be the third with Egypt and with Assyria, a blessing within the earth; ²⁵because the LORD of Hosts has blessed them, saying, "Blessed be Egypt my people, Assyria the work of my hands, and Israel my inheritance."

20In the year that Tartan came to Ashdod, when Sargon the king of Assyria sent him, and he fought against Ashdod and took it; ²at that time the LORD spoke by Isaiah the son of Amoz, saying, "Go, and loosen the sackcloth from off your waist, and take your sandals from off your feet." He did so, walking naked and barefoot. ³The LORD said, "As my servant Isaiah has walked naked and barefoot three years for a sign and a wonder concerning Egypt and concerning Ethiopia, ⁴so the king of Assyria will lead away the captives of Egypt and the exiles of Ethiopia, young and old, naked and barefoot, and with buttocks uncovered, to the shame of Egypt. ⁵They will be dismayed and confounded, because of Ethiopia their expectation, and of Egypt their glory. ⁶The inhabitants of this coast land will say in that day, 'Behold, this is our expectation, where we fled for help to be delivered from the king of Assyria. And we, how will we escape?'"

21The burden of the wilderness of the sea. As whirlwinds in the South sweep through, it comes from the wilderness, from an awesome land. ²A grievous vision is declared to me. The treacherous man deals treacherously, and the destroyer destroys. Go up, Elam; attack! I have stopped all of Media's sighing. ³Therefore my thighs are filled with anguish. Pains have seized me, like the pains of a woman in labor. I am in so much pain that I can't hear. I am so dismayed that I can't see. ⁴My heart flutters. Horror has frightened me. The twilight that I desired has been turned into trembling for me. ⁵They prepare the table. They set the watch. They eat. They drink. Rise up, you princes, oil the shield! ⁶For the Lord said to me, "Go, set a watchman. Let him declare what he sees. ⁷When he sees a troop, horsemen in pairs, a troop of donkeys, a troop of camels, he shall listen diligently with great attentiveness." ⁸He cried like a lion: "Lord, I stand continually on the watchtower in the daytime, and every night I stay at my post. ⁹Behold, here comes a troop of men, horsemen in pairs." He answered, "Fallen, fallen is Babylon; and all the engraved images of her gods are broken to the ground. ¹⁰You are my threshing, and the grain of my floor!" That which I

have heard from the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, I have declared to you. ¹¹The burden of Dumah. One calls to me out of Seir, "Watchman, what of the night? Watchman, what of the night?" ¹²The watchman said, "The morning comes, and also the night. If you will inquire, inquire. Come back again." ¹³The burden on Arabia. You will lodge in the thickets in Arabia, you caravans of Dedanites. ¹⁴They brought water to him who was thirsty. The inhabitants of the land of Tema met the fugitives with their bread. ¹⁵For they fled away from the swords, from the drawn sword, from the bent bow, and from the heat of battle. ¹⁶For the Lord said to me, "Within a year, as a worker bound by contract would count it, all the glory of Kedar will fail, ¹⁷and the residue of the number of the archers, the mighty men of the children of Kedar, will be few; for the LORD, the God of Israel, has spoken it."

22The burden of the valley of vision. What ails you now, that you have all gone up to the housetops? ²You that are full of shouting, a tumultuous city, a joyous town, your slain are not slain with the sword, neither are they dead in battle. ³All your rulers fled away together. They were bound by the archers. All who were found by you were bound together. They fled far away. ⁴Therefore I said, "Look away from me. I will weep bitterly. Don't labor to comfort me for the destruction of the daughter of my people. ⁵For it is a day of confusion, and of treading down, and of perplexity from the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, in the valley of vision, a breaking down of the walls, and a crying to the mountains." ⁶Elam carried his quiver, with chariots of men and horsemen; and Kir uncovered the shield. ⁷Your choicest valleys were full of chariots, and the horsemen set themselves in array at the gate. ⁸He took away the covering of Judah; and you looked in that day to the armor in the house of the forest. ⁹You saw the breaches of David's city, that they were many; and you gathered together the waters of the lower pool. ¹⁰You counted the houses of Jerusalem, and you broke down the houses to fortify the wall. ¹¹You also made a reservoir between the two walls for the water of the old pool. But you didn't look to him who had done this, neither did you have respect for him who planned it long ago. ¹²In that day, the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, called to weeping, to mourning, to baldness, and to dressing in sackcloth; ¹³and behold, there is joy and gladness, killing cattle and killing sheep, eating meat and drinking wine: "Let's eat and drink, for tomorrow we will die." ¹⁴The LORD of Hosts revealed himself in my ears, "Surely this iniquity will not be forgiven you until you die," says the Lord, the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁵The Lord, the LORD of Hosts says, "Go, get yourself to this treasurer, even to Shebna, who is over the house, and say, ¹⁶'What are you doing here? Who has you here, that you have dug out a tomb here?' Cutting himself out a tomb on high, chiseling a habitation for himself in the rock!" ¹⁷Behold, the LORD

will overcome you and hurl you away violently. Yes, he will grasp you firmly. ¹⁸He will surely wind you around and around, and throw you like a ball into a large country. There you will die, and there the chariots of your glory will be, you disgrace of your lord's house. ¹⁹I will thrust you from your office. You will be pulled down from your station. ²⁰It will happen in that day that I will call my servant Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, ²¹and I will clothe him with your robe, and strengthen him with your belt. I will commit your government into his hand; and he will be a father to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to the house of Judah. ²²I will lay the key of David's house on his shoulder. He will open, and no one will shut. He will shut, and no one will open. ²³I will fasten him like a nail in a sure place. He will be for a throne of glory to his father's house. ²⁴They will hang on him all the glory of his father's house, the offspring and the issue, every small vessel, from the cups even to all the pitchers. ²⁵"In that day," says the LORD of Hosts, "the nail that was fastened in a sure place will give way. It will be cut down and fall. The burden that was on it will be cut off, for the LORD has spoken it."

23The burden of Tyre. Howl, you ships of Tarshish! For it is laid waste, so that there is no house, no entering in. From the land of Kittim it is revealed to them. ²Be still, you inhabitants of the coast, you whom the merchants of Sidon that pass over the sea have replenished. ³On great waters, the seed of the Shihor, the harvest of the Nile, was her revenue. She was the market of nations. ⁴Be ashamed, Sidon; for the sea has spoken, the stronghold of the sea, saying, "I have not travailed, nor given birth, neither have I nourished young men, nor brought up virgins." ⁵When the report comes to Egypt, they will be in anguish at the report of Tyre. ⁶Pass over to Tarshish! Wail, you inhabitants of the coast! ⁷Is this your joyous city, whose antiquity is of ancient days, whose feet carried her far away to travel? ⁸Who has planned this against Tyre, the giver of crowns, whose merchants are princes, whose traders are the honorable of the earth? ⁹The LORD of Hosts has planned it, to stain the pride of all glory, to bring into contempt all the honorable of the earth. ¹⁰Pass through your land like the Nile, daughter of Tarshish. There is no restraint any more. ¹¹He has stretched out his hand over the sea. He has shaken the kingdoms. The LORD has ordered the destruction of Canaan's strongholds. ¹²He said, "You shall rejoice no more, you oppressed virgin daughter of Sidon. Arise, pass over to Kittim. Even there you will have no rest." ¹³Behold, the land of the Kasdim. This people didn't exist. The Assyrians founded it for those who dwell in the wilderness. They set up their towers. They overthrew its palaces. They made it a ruin. ¹⁴Howl, you ships of Tarshish, for your stronghold is laid waste! ¹⁵It will come to pass in that day that Tyre will be forgotten

seventy years, according to the days of one king. After the end of seventy years it will be to Tyre like in the song of the prostitute. ¹⁶Take a harp; go about the city, you prostitute that has been forgotten. Make sweet melody. Sing many songs, that you may be remembered. ¹⁷It will happen after the end of seventy years that the LORD will visit Tyre. She will return to her wages, and will play the prostitute with all the kingdoms of the world on the surface of the earth. ¹⁸Her merchandise and her wages will be holiness to the LORD. It will not be treasured nor laid up; for her merchandise will be for those who dwell before the LORD, to eat sufficiently, and for durable clothing.

24Behold, the LORD makes the earth empty, makes it waste, turns it upside down, and scatters its inhabitants. ²It will be as with the people, so with the priest; as with the servant, so with his master; as with the maid, so with her mistress; as with the buyer, so with the seller; as with the creditor, so with the debtor; as with the taker of interest, so with the giver of interest. ³The earth will be utterly emptied and utterly laid waste; for the LORD has spoken this word. ⁴The earth mourns and fades away. The world languishes and fades away. The lofty people of the earth languish. ⁵The earth also is polluted under its inhabitants, because they have transgressed the laws, violated the statutes, and broken the everlasting covenant. ⁶Therefore the curse has devoured the earth, and those who dwell therein are found guilty. Therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, and few men are left. ⁷The new wine mourns. The vine languishes. All the merry-hearted sigh. ⁸The mirth of tambourines ceases. The sound of those who rejoice ends. The joy of the harp ceases. ⁹They will not drink wine with a song. Strong drink will be bitter to those who drink it. ¹⁰The confused city is broken down. Every house is shut up, that no man may come in. ¹¹There is a crying in the streets because of the wine. All joy is darkened. The mirth of the land is gone. ¹²The city is left in desolation, and the gate is struck with destruction. ¹³For it will be so within the earth among the peoples, as the shaking of an olive tree, as the gleanings when the vintage is done. ¹⁴These shall lift up their voice. They will shout for the majesty of the LORD. They cry aloud from the sea. ¹⁵Therefore glorify the LORD in the east, even the name of the LORD, the God of Israel, in the islands of the sea! ¹⁶From the uttermost part of the earth have we heard songs. Glory to the righteous! But I said, "I pine away! I pine away! woe is me!" The treacherous have dealt treacherously. Yes, the treacherous have dealt very treacherously. ¹⁷Fear, the pit, and the snare are on you who inhabit the earth. ¹⁸It will happen that he who flees from the noise of the fear will fall into the pit; and he who comes up out of the middle of the pit will be taken in the snare; for the windows on high are opened, and the foundations of the earth tremble. ¹⁹The earth

is utterly broken. The earth is torn apart. The earth is shaken violently. ²⁰The earth will stagger like a drunken man, and will sway back and forth like a hammock. Its disobedience will be heavy on it, and it will fall and not rise again. ²¹It will happen in that day that the LORD will punish the army of the high ones on high, and the kings of the earth on the earth. ²²They will be gathered together, as prisoners are gathered in the pit, and will be shut up in the prison; and after many days they will be visited. ²³Then the moon will be confounded, and the sun ashamed; for the LORD of Hosts will reign on Mount Zion and in Jerusalem; and glory will be before his elders.

25The LORD, you are my God. I will exalt you! I will praise your name, for you have done wonderful things, things planned long ago, in complete faithfulness and truth. ²For you have made a city into a heap, a fortified city into a ruin, a palace of strangers to be no city. It will never be built. ³Therefore a strong people will glorify you. A city of awesome nations will fear you. ⁴For you have been a stronghold to the poor, a stronghold to the needy in his distress, a refuge from the storm, a shade from the heat, when the blast of the dreaded ones is like a storm against the wall. ⁵As the heat in a dry place you will bring down the noise of strangers; as the heat by the shade of a cloud, the song of the dreaded ones will be brought low. ⁶In this mountain, the LORD of Hosts will make all peoples a feast of choice meat, ^{xviii} a feast of choice wines, of choice meat full of marrow, of well refined choice wines. ⁷He will destroy in this mountain the surface of the covering that covers all peoples, and the veil that is spread over all nations. ⁸He has swallowed up death forever! The Lord GOD will wipe away tears from off all faces. He will take the reproach of his people away from off all the earth, for the LORD has spoken it. ⁹It shall be said in that day, "Behold, this is our God! We have waited for him, and he will save us! This is the LORD! We have waited for him. We will be glad and rejoice in his salvation!" ¹⁰For the LORD's hand will rest in this mountain. Moab will be trodden down in his place, even like straw is trodden down in the water of the dunghill. ¹¹He will spread out his hands in the middle of it, like one who swims spreads out hands to swim, but his pride will be humbled together with the craft of his hands. ¹²He has brought the high fortress of your walls down, laid low, and brought to the ground, even to the dust.

26In that day, this song will be sung in the land of Judah: "We have a strong city. God appoints salvation for walls and bulwarks. ²Open the gates, that the righteous nation may enter: the one which keeps faith. ³You will keep whoever's mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you. ⁴Trust in the LORD forever; for in the

LORD, the LORD, is an everlasting Rock. ⁵For he has brought down those who dwell on high, the lofty city. He lays it low. He lays it low even to the ground. He brings it even to the dust. ⁶The foot shall tread it down, even the feet of the poor and the steps of the needy." ⁷The way of the just is uprightness. You who are upright make the path of the righteous level. ⁸Yes, in the way of your judgments, the LORD, we have waited for you. Your name and your renown are the desire of our soul. ⁹With my soul I have desired you in the night. Yes, with my spirit within me I will seek you earnestly; for when your judgments are in the earth, the inhabitants of the world learn righteousness. ¹⁰Let favor be shown to the wicked, yet he will not learn righteousness. In the land of uprightness he will deal wrongfully, and will not see the LORD's majesty. ¹¹The LORD, your hand is lifted up, yet they don't see; but they will see your zeal for the people and be disappointed. Yes, fire will consume your adversaries. ¹²The LORD, you will ordain peace for us, for you have also done all our work for us. ¹³The LORD our God, other lords besides you have had dominion over us, but we will only acknowledge your name. ¹⁴The dead shall not live. The departed spirits shall not rise. Therefore you have visited and destroyed them, and caused all memory of them to perish. ¹⁵You have increased the nation, O LORD. You have increased the nation! You are glorified! You have enlarged all the borders of the land. ¹⁶LORD, in trouble they have visited you. They poured out a prayer when your chastening was on them. ¹⁷Just as a woman with child, who draws near the time of her delivery, is in pain and cries out in her pangs, so we have been before you, LORD. ¹⁸We have been with child. We have been in pain. We gave birth, it seems, only to wind. We have not worked any deliverance in the earth; neither have the inhabitants of the world fallen. ¹⁹Your dead shall live. Their dead bodies shall arise. Awake and sing, you who dwell in the dust; for your dew is like the dew of herbs, and the earth will cast out the departed spirits. ²⁰Come, my people, enter into your rooms, and shut your doors behind you. Hide yourself for a little moment, until the indignation is past. ²¹For, behold, the LORD comes out of his place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity. The earth also will disclose her blood, and will no longer cover her slain.

27In that day, the LORD with his hard and great and strong sword will punish leviathan, the fleeing serpent, and leviathan, the twisted serpent; and he will kill the dragon that is in the sea. ²In that day, sing to her, "A pleasant vineyard! ³I, the LORD, am its keeper. I will water it every moment. Lest anyone damage it, I will keep it night and day. ⁴Wrath is not in me, but if I should find briers and thorns, I would do battle! I would march on them and I would burn them together. ⁵Or else let him take hold of

^{xviii}literally, fat things

my strength, that he may make peace with me. Let him make peace with me.” ⁶In days to come, Jacob will take root. Israel will blossom and bud. They will fill the surface of the world with fruit. ⁷Has he struck them as he struck those who struck them? Or are they killed like those who killed them were killed? ⁸In measure, when you send them away, you contend with them. He has removed them with his rough blast in the day of the east wind. ⁹Therefore by this the iniquity of Jacob will be forgiven, and this is all the fruit of taking away his sin: that he makes all the stones of the altar as chalk stones that are beaten in pieces, so that the Asherah poles and the incense altars shall rise no more. ¹⁰For the fortified city is solitary, a habitation deserted and forsaken, like the wilderness. The calf will feed there, and there he will lie down, and consume its branches. ¹¹When its boughs are withered, they will be broken off. The women will come and set them on fire, for they are a people of no understanding. Therefore he who made them will not have compassion on them, and he who formed them will show them no favor. ¹²It will happen in that day that the LORD will thresh from the flowing stream of the Euphrates to the brook of Egypt; and you will be gathered one by one, children of Israel. ¹³It will happen in that day that a great shofar will be blown; and those who were ready to perish in the land of Assyria, and those who were outcasts in the land of Egypt, shall come; and they will worship the LORD in the holy mountain at Jerusalem.

28Woe to the crown of pride of the drunkards of Ephraim, and to the fading flower of his glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fertile valley of those who are overcome with wine! ²Behold, the Lord has one who is mighty and strong. Like a storm of hail, a destroying storm, and like a storm of mighty waters overflowing, he will cast them down to the earth with his hand. ³The crown of pride of the drunkards of Ephraim will be trodden under foot. ⁴The fading flower of his glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fertile valley, shall be like the first-ripe fig before the summer, which someone picks and eats as soon as he sees it. ⁵In that day, the LORD of Hosts will become a crown of glory and a diadem of beauty to the residue of his people, ⁶and a spirit of justice to him who sits in judgment, and strength to those who turn back the battle at the gate. ⁷They also reel with wine, and stagger with strong drink. The priest and the prophet reel with strong drink. They are swallowed up by wine. They stagger with strong drink. They err in vision. They stumble in judgment. ⁸For all tables are completely full of filthy vomit and filthiness. ⁹Whom will he teach knowledge? To whom will he explain the message? Those who are weaned from the milk, and drawn from the breasts? ¹⁰For it is precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little. ¹¹But he will speak to

this nation with stammering lips and in another language, ¹²to whom he said, “This is the resting place. Give rest to the weary,” and “This is the refreshing;” yet they would not hear. ¹³Therefore the LORD’s word will be to them precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little; that they may go, fall backward, be broken, be snared, and be taken. ¹⁴Therefore hear the LORD’s word, you scoffers, that rule this people in Jerusalem: ¹⁵“Because you have said, ‘We have made a covenant with death, and we are in agreement with Sheol.’” ^{xix} When the overflowing scourge passes through, it won’t come to us; for we have made lies our refuge, and we have hidden ourselves under falsehood.” ¹⁶Therefore the Lord GOD says, “Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious cornerstone of a sure foundation. He who believes shall not act hastily. ¹⁷I will make justice the measuring line, and righteousness the plumb line. The hail will sweep away the refuge of lies, and the waters will overflow the hiding place. ¹⁸Your covenant with death shall be annulled, and your agreement with Sheol ^{xx} shall not stand. When the overflowing scourge passes through, then you will be trampled down by it. ¹⁹As often as it passes through, it will seize you; for morning by morning it will pass through, by day and by night; and it will be nothing but terror to understand the message.” ²⁰For the bed is too short to stretch out on, and the blanket is too narrow to wrap oneself in. ²¹For the LORD will rise up as on Mount Perazim. He will be angry as in the valley of Gibeon; that he may do his work, his unusual work, and bring to pass his act, his extraordinary act. ²²Now therefore don’t be scoffers, lest your bonds be made strong; for I have heard a decree of destruction from the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, on the whole earth. ²³Give ear, and hear my voice! Listen, and hear my speech! ²⁴Does he who plows to sow plow continually? Does he keep turning the soil and breaking the clods? ²⁵When he has leveled its surface, doesn’t he plant the dill, and scatter the cumin seed, and put in the wheat in rows, the barley in the appointed place, and the spelt in its place? ²⁶For his God instructs him in right judgment and teaches him. ²⁷For the dill isn’t threshed with a sharp instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned over the cumin; but the dill is beaten out with a stick, and the cumin with a rod. ²⁸Bread flour must be ground; so he will not always be threshing it. Although he drives the wheel of his threshing cart over it, his horses don’t grind it. ²⁹This also comes out from the LORD of Hosts, who is wonderful in counsel, and excellent in wisdom.

29Woe to Ariel! Ariel, the city where David encamped! Add year to year; let the feasts come around; ²then I will distress Ariel, and there will be mourning and lamenta-

^{xix}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xx}Sheol is the place of the dead.

tion. She shall be to me as an altar hearth. ^{xxi} ³I will encamp against you all around you, and will lay siege against you with posted troops. I will raise siege works against you. ⁴You will be brought down, and will speak out of the ground. Your speech will mumble out of the dust. Your voice will be as of one who has a familiar spirit, out of the ground, and your speech will whisper out of the dust. ⁵But the multitude of your foes will be like fine dust, and the multitude of the ruthless ones like chaff that blows away. Yes, it will be in an instant, suddenly. ⁶She will be visited by the LORD of Hosts with thunder, with earthquake, with great noise, with whirlwind and storm, and with the flame of a devouring fire. ⁷The multitude of all the nations that fight against Ariel, even all who fight against her and her stronghold, and who distress her, will be like a dream, a vision of the night. ⁸It will be like when a hungry man dreams, and behold, he eats; but he awakes, and his hunger isn't satisfied; or like when a thirsty man dreams, and behold, he drinks; but he awakes, and behold, he is faint, and he is still thirsty. The multitude of all the nations that fight against Mount Zion will be like that. ⁹Pause and wonder! Blind yourselves and be blind! They are drunken, but not with wine; they stagger, but not with strong drink. ¹⁰For the LORD has poured out on you a spirit of deep sleep, and has closed your eyes, the prophets; and he has covered your heads, the seers. ¹¹All vision has become to you like the words of a book that is sealed, which men deliver to one who is educated, saying, "Read this, please;" and he says, "I can't, for it is sealed;" ¹²and the book is delivered to one who is not educated, saying, "Read this, please;" and he says, "I can't read." ¹³The Lord said, "Because this people draws near with their mouth and honors me with their lips, but they have removed their heart far from me, and their fear of me is a commandment of men which has been taught; ¹⁴therefore, behold, I will proceed to do a marvelous work among this people, even a marvelous work and a wonder; and the wisdom of their wise men will perish, and the understanding of their prudent men will be hidden." ¹⁵Woe to those who deeply hide their counsel from the LORD, and whose deeds are in the dark, and who say, "Who sees us?" and "Who knows us?" ¹⁶You turn things upside down! Should the potter be thought to be like clay, that the thing made should say about him who made it, "He didn't make me;" or the thing formed say of him who formed it, "He has no understanding?" ¹⁷Isn't it yet a very little while, and Lebanon will be turned into a fruitful field, and the fruitful field will be regarded as a forest? ¹⁸In that day, the deaf will hear the words of the book, and the eyes of the blind will see out of obscurity and out of darkness. ¹⁹The humble also will increase their joy in the LORD, and the poor among men will rejoice in the Holy One of Israel. ²⁰For the ruthless is brought to nothing, and the scoffer ceases, and

all those who are alert to do evil are cut off— ²¹who cause a person to be indicted by a word, and lay a snare for one who reproves in the gate, and who deprive the innocent of justice with false testimony. ²²Therefore the LORD, who redeemed Abraham, says concerning the house of Jacob: "Jacob shall no longer be ashamed, neither shall his face grow pale. ²³But when he sees his children, the work of my hands, in the middle of him, they will sanctify my name. Yes, they will sanctify the Holy One of Jacob, and will stand in awe of the God of Israel. ²⁴They also who err in spirit will come to understanding, and those who grumble will receive instruction."

30"Woe to the rebellious children", says the LORD, "who take counsel, but not from me; and who make an alliance, but not with my Spirit, that they may add sin to sin; ²who set out to go down into Egypt without asking for my advice, to strengthen themselves in the strength of Pharaoh, and to take refuge in the shadow of Egypt! ³Therefore the strength of Pharaoh will be your shame, and the refuge in the shadow of Egypt your confusion. ⁴For their princes are at Zoan, and their ambassadors have come to Hanes. ⁵They shall all be ashamed because of a people that can't profit them, that are not a help nor profit, but a shame, and also a reproach." ⁶The burden of the animals of the South. Through the land of trouble and anguish, of the lioness and the lion, the viper and fiery flying serpent, they carry their riches on the shoulders of young donkeys, and their treasures on the humps of camels, to an unprofitable people. ⁷For Egypt helps in vain, and to no purpose; therefore I have called her Rahab who sits still. ⁸Now go, write it before them on a tablet, and inscribe it in a book, that it may be for the time to come forever and ever. ⁹For it is a rebellious people, lying children, children who will not hear the LORD's law; ¹⁰who tell the seers, "Don't see!" and the prophets, "Don't prophesy to us right things. Tell us pleasant things. Prophecy deceits. ¹¹Get out of the way. Turn away from the path. Cause the Holy One of Israel to cease from before us." ¹²Therefore the Holy One of Israel says, "Because you despise this word, and trust in oppression and perverseness, and rely on it, ¹³therefore this iniquity shall be to you like a breach ready to fall, swelling out in a high wall, whose breaking comes suddenly in an instant. ¹⁴He will break it as a potter's vessel is broken, breaking it in pieces without sparing, so that there won't be found among the broken pieces a piece good enough to take fire from the hearth, or to dip up water out of the cistern." ¹⁵For thus said the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel, "You will be saved in returning and rest. Your strength will be in quietness and in confidence." You refused, ¹⁶but you said, "No, for we will flee on horses;" therefore you will flee; and, "We will ride on the swift;" therefore those who pursue you will be swift. ¹⁷One thousand will flee at the threat of one. At the threat of five, you will flee until

^{xxi}or, Ariel

you are left like a beacon on the top of a mountain, and like a banner on a hill. ¹⁸Therefore the LORD will wait, that he may be gracious to you; and therefore he will be exalted, that he may have mercy on you, for the LORD is a God of justice. Blessed are all those who wait for him. ¹⁹For the people will dwell in Zion at Jerusalem. You will weep no more. He will surely be gracious to you at the voice of your cry. When he hears you, he will answer you. ²⁰Though the Lord may give you the bread of adversity and the water of affliction, yet your teachers won't be hidden any more, but your eyes will see your teachers; ²¹and when you turn to the right hand, and when you turn to the left, your ears will hear a voice behind you, saying, "This is the way. Walk in it." ²²You shall defile the overlaying of your engraved images of silver, and the plating of your molten images of gold. You shall cast them away as an unclean thing. You shall tell it, "Go away!" ²³He will give the rain for your seed, with which you will sow the ground; and bread of the increase of the ground will be rich and plentiful. In that day, your livestock will feed in large pastures. ²⁴The oxen likewise and the young donkeys that till the ground will eat savory feed, which has been winnowed with the shovel and with the fork. ²⁵There will be brooks and streams of water on every lofty mountain and on every high hill in the day of the great slaughter, when the towers fall. ²⁶Moreover the light of the moon will be like the light of the sun, and the light of the sun will be seven times brighter, like the light of seven days, in the day that the LORD binds up the fracture of his people, and heals the wound they were struck with. ²⁷Behold, the LORD's name comes from far away, burning with his anger, and in thick rising smoke. His lips are full of indignation. His tongue is as a devouring fire. ²⁸His breath is as an overflowing stream that reaches even to the neck, to sift the nations with the sieve of destruction. A bridle that leads to ruin will be in the jaws of the peoples. ²⁹You will have a song, as in the night when a holy feast is kept, and gladness of heart, as when one goes with a flute to come to the LORD's mountain, to Israel's Rock. ³⁰The LORD will cause his glorious voice to be heard, and will show the descent of his arm, with the indignation of his anger and the flame of a devouring fire, with a blast, storm, and hailstones. ³¹For through the LORD's voice the Assyrian will be dismayed. He will strike him with his rod. ³²Every stroke of the rod of punishment, which the LORD will lay on him, will be with the sound of tambourines and harps. He will fight with them in battles, brandishing weapons. ³³For his burning place has long been ready. Yes, it is prepared for the king. He has made its pyre deep and large with fire and much wood. The LORD's breath, like a stream of sulfur, kindles it.

31Woe to those who go down to Egypt for help, and rely on horses, and trust in chariots because they are many,

and in horsemen because they are very strong, but they don't look to the Holy One of Israel, and they don't seek the LORD! ²Yet he also is wise, and will bring disaster, and will not call back his words, but will arise against the house of the evildoers, and against the help of those who work iniquity. ³Now the Egyptians are men, and not God; and their horses flesh, and not spirit. When the LORD stretches out his hand, both he who helps shall stumble, and he who is helped shall fall, and they all shall be consumed together. ⁴For the LORD says to me, "As the lion and the young lion growling over his prey, if a multitude of shepherds is called together against him, will not be dismayed at their voice, nor abase himself for their noise, so the LORD of Hosts will come down to fight on Mount Zion and on its heights. ⁵As birds hovering, so the LORD of Hosts will protect Jerusalem. He will protect and deliver it. He will pass over and preserve it." ⁶Return to him from whom you have deeply revolted, children of Israel. ⁷For in that day everyone shall cast away his idols of silver and his idols of gold—sin which your own hands have made for you. ⁸"The Assyrian will fall by the sword, not of man; and the sword, not of mankind, shall devour him. He will flee from the sword, and his young men will become subject to forced labor. ⁹His rock will pass away by reason of terror, and his princes will be afraid of the banner," says the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, and his furnace in Jerusalem.

32Behold, a king shall reign in righteousness, and princes shall rule in justice. ²A man shall be as a hiding place from the wind, and a covert from the storm, as streams of water in a dry place, as the shade of a large rock in a weary land. ³The eyes of those who see will not be dim, and the ears of those who hear will listen. ⁴The heart of the rash will understand knowledge, and the tongue of the stammerers will be ready to speak plainly. ⁵The fool will no longer be called noble, nor the scoundrel be highly respected. ⁶For the fool will speak folly, and his heart will work iniquity, to practice profanity, and to utter error against the LORD, to make empty the soul of the hungry, and to cause the drink of the thirsty to fail. ⁷The ways of the scoundrel are evil. He devises wicked plans to destroy the humble with lying words, even when the needy speaks right. ⁸But the noble devises noble things, and he will continue in noble things. ⁹Rise up, you women who are at ease! Hear my voice! You careless daughters, give ear to my speech! ¹⁰For days beyond a year you will be troubled, you careless women; for the vintage will fail. The harvest won't come. ¹¹Tremble, you women who are at ease! Be troubled, you careless ones! Strip yourselves, make yourselves naked, and put sackcloth on your waist. ¹²Beat your breasts for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vine. ¹³Thorns and briars will come up on my people's land; yes, on all the houses of joy in the joyous city. ¹⁴For the palace will be forsaken. The populous city

will be deserted. The hill and the watchtower will be for dens forever, a delight for wild donkeys, a pasture of flocks, ¹⁵until the Spirit is poured on us from on high, and the wilderness becomes a fruitful field, and the fruitful field is considered a forest. ¹⁶Then justice will dwell in the wilderness; and righteousness will remain in the fruitful field. ¹⁷The work of righteousness will be peace, and the effect of righteousness, quietness and confidence forever. ¹⁸My people will live in a peaceful habitation, in safe dwellings, and in quiet resting places, ¹⁹though hail flattens the forest, and the city is leveled completely. ²⁰Blessed are you who sow beside all waters, who send out the feet of the ox and the donkey.

33Woe to you who destroy, but you weren't destroyed, and who betray, but nobody betrayed you! When you have finished destroying, you will be destroyed; and when you have finished betrayal, you will be betrayed. ²LORD, be gracious to us. We have waited for you. Be our strength every morning, our salvation also in the time of trouble. ³At the noise of the thunder, the peoples have fled. When you lift yourself up, the nations are scattered. ⁴Your plunder will be gathered as the caterpillar gathers. Men will leap on it as locusts leap. ⁵The LORD is exalted, for he dwells on high. He has filled Zion with justice and righteousness. ⁶There will be stability in your times, abundance of salvation, wisdom, and knowledge. The fear of the LORD is your treasure. ⁷Behold, their valiant ones cry outside; the ambassadors of peace weep bitterly. ⁸The highways are desolate. The traveling man ceases. The covenant is broken. He has despised the cities. He doesn't respect man. ⁹The land mourns and languishes. Lebanon is confounded and withers away. Sharon is like a desert, and Bashan and Carmel are stripped bare. ¹⁰"Now I will arise," says the LORD. "Now I will lift myself up. Now I will be exalted. ¹¹You will conceive chaff. You will give birth to stubble. Your breath is a fire that will devour you. ¹²The peoples will be like the burning of lime, like thorns that are cut down and burned in the fire. ¹³Hear, you who are far off, what I have done; and, you who are near, acknowledge my might." ¹⁴The sinners in Zion are afraid. Trembling has seized the godless ones. Who among us can live with the devouring fire? Who among us can live with everlasting burning? ¹⁵He who walks righteously and speaks blamelessly, he who despises the gain of oppressions, who gestures with his hands, refusing to take a bribe, who stops his ears from hearing of bloodshed, and shuts his eyes from looking at evil— ¹⁶he will dwell on high. His place of defense will be the fortress of rocks. His bread will be supplied. His waters will be sure. ¹⁷Your eyes will see the king in his beauty. They will see a distant land. ¹⁸Your heart will meditate on the terror. Where is he who counted? Where is he who weighed? Where is he who counted the towers? ¹⁹You will no longer see

the fierce people, a people of a deep speech that you can't comprehend, with a strange language that you can't understand. ²⁰Look at Zion, the city of our appointed festivals. Your eyes will see Jerusalem, a quiet habitation, a tent that won't be removed. Its stakes will never be plucked up, nor will any of its cords be broken. ²¹But there the LORD will be with us in majesty, a place of wide rivers and streams, in which no galley with oars will go, neither will any gallant ship pass by there. ²²For the LORD is our judge. The LORD is our lawgiver. The LORD is our king. He will save us. ²³Your rigging is untied. They couldn't strengthen the foot of their mast. They couldn't spread the sail. Then the prey of a great plunder was divided. The lame took the prey. ²⁴The inhabitant won't say, "I am sick." The people who dwell therein will be forgiven their iniquity.

34Come near, you nations, to hear! Listen, you peoples. Let the earth and all it contains hear, the world, and everything that comes from it. ²For the LORD is enraged against all the nations, and angry with all their armies. He has utterly destroyed them. He has given them over for slaughter. ³Their slain will also be cast out, and the stench of their dead bodies will come up. The mountains will melt in their blood. ⁴All of the army of the sky will be dissolved. The sky will be rolled up like a scroll, and all its armies will fade away, as a leaf fades from off a vine or a fig tree. ⁵For my sword has drunk its fill in the sky. Behold, it will come down on Edom, and on the people of my curse, for judgment. ⁶The LORD's sword is filled with blood. It is covered with fat, with the blood of lambs and goats, with the fat of the kidneys of rams; for the LORD has a sacrifice in Bozrah, and a great slaughter in the land of Edom. ⁷The wild oxen will come down with them, and the young bulls with the mighty bulls; and their land will be drunken with blood, and their dust made greasy with fat. ⁸For the LORD has a day of vengeance, a year of recompense for the cause of Zion. ⁹Its streams will be turned into pitch, its dust into sulfur, and its land will become burning pitch. ¹⁰It won't be quenched night or day. Its smoke will go up forever. From generation to generation, it will lie waste. No one will pass through it forever and ever. ¹¹But the pelican and the porcupine will possess it. The owl and the raven will dwell in it. He will stretch the line of confusion over it, and the plumb line of emptiness. ¹²They shall call its nobles to the kingdom, but none shall be there; and all its princes shall be nothing. ¹³Thorns will come up in its palaces, nettles and thistles in its fortresses; and it will be a habitation of jackals, a court for ostriches. ¹⁴The wild animals of the desert will meet with the wolves, and the wild goat will cry to his fellow. Yes, the night creature ^{xxii} shall settle there, and shall find herself a place of

^{xxii}literally, lilith, which could also be a night demon or night monster

rest. ¹⁵The arrow snake will make her nest there, and lay, hatch, and gather under her shade. Yes, the kites will be gathered there, every one with her mate. ¹⁶Search in the book of the LORD, and read: not one of these will be missing. None will lack her mate. For my mouth has commanded, and his Spirit has gathered them. ¹⁷He has cast the lot for them, and his hand has divided it to them with a measuring line. They shall possess it forever. From generation to generation they will dwell in it.

35The wilderness and the dry land will be glad. The desert will rejoice and blossom like a rose. ²It will blossom abundantly, and rejoice even with joy and singing. Lebanon's glory will be given to it, the excellence of Carmel and Sharon. They will see the LORD's glory, the excellence of our God. ³Strengthen the weak hands, and make the feeble knees firm. ⁴Tell those who have a fearful heart, "Be strong! Don't be afraid! Behold, your God will come with vengeance, God's retribution. He will come and save you. ⁵Then the eyes of the blind will be opened, and the ears of the deaf will be unstopped. ⁶Then the lame man will leap like a deer, and the tongue of the mute will sing; for waters will break out in the wilderness, and streams in the desert. ⁷The burning sand will become a pool, and the thirsty ground springs of water. Grass with reeds and rushes will be in the habitation of jackals, where they lay. ⁸A highway will be there, a road, and it will be called "The Holy Way". The unclean shall not pass over it, but it will be for those who walk in the Way. Wicked fools shall not go there. ⁹No lion will be there, nor will any ravenous animal go up on it. They will not be found there; but the redeemed will walk there. ¹⁰Then the LORD's ransomed ones will return, and come with singing to Zion; and everlasting joy will be on their heads. They will obtain gladness and joy, and sorrow and sighing will flee away."

36Now in the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria attacked all of the fortified cities of Judah and captured them. ²The king of Assyria sent Rabshakeh from Lachish to Jerusalem to King Hezekiah with a large army. He stood by the aqueduct from the upper pool in the fuller's field highway. ³Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph the recorder came out to him. ⁴Rabshakeh said to them, "Now tell Hezekiah, 'The great king, the king of Assyria, says, "What confidence is this in which you trust? ⁵I say that your counsel and strength for the war are only vain words. Now in whom do you trust, that you have rebelled against me? ⁶Behold, you trust in the staff of this bruised reed, even in Egypt, which if a man leans on it, it will go into his hand and pierce it. So is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust in him. ⁷But if you tell me, 'We trust in the LORD our God,' isn't that he whose high places and whose altars

Hezekiah has taken away, and has said to Judah and to Jerusalem, 'You shall worship before this altar?'" ⁸Now therefore, please make a pledge to my master the king of Assyria, and I will give you two thousand horses, if you are able on your part to set riders on them. ⁹How then can you turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master's servants, and put your trust in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen? ¹⁰Have I come up now without the LORD against this land to destroy it? the LORD said to me, "Go up against this land, and destroy it."'" ¹¹Then Eliakim, Shebna and Joah said to Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, for we understand it. Don't speak to us in the Jews' language in the hearing of the people who are on the wall." ¹²But Rabshakeh said, "Has my master sent me only to your master and to you, to speak these words, and not to the men who sit on the wall, who will eat their own dung and drink their own urine with you?" ¹³Then Rabshakeh stood, and called out with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and said, "Hear the words of the great king, the king of Assyria! ¹⁴The king says, 'Don't let Hezekiah deceive you; for he will not be able to deliver you. ¹⁵Don't let Hezekiah make you trust in the LORD, saying, "The LORD will surely deliver us. This city won't be given into the hand of the king of Assyria."'" ¹⁶Don't listen to Hezekiah, for the king of Assyria says, 'Make your peace with me, and come out to me; and each of you eat from his vine, and each one from his fig tree, and each one of you drink the waters of his own cistern; ¹⁷until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards. ¹⁸Beware lest Hezekiah persuade you, saying, "The LORD will deliver us." Have any of the gods of the nations delivered their lands from the hand of the king of Assyria? ¹⁹Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim? Have they delivered Samaria from my hand? ²⁰Who are they among all the gods of these countries that have delivered their country out of my hand, that the LORD should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?'" ²¹But they remained silent, and said nothing in reply, for the king's commandment was, "Don't answer him." ²²Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph the recorder, came to Hezekiah with their clothes torn, and told him the words of Rabshakeh.

37When King Hezekiah heard it, he tore his clothes, covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the LORD's house. ²He sent Eliakim, who was over the household, and Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz. ³They said to him, "Hezekiah says, 'Today is a day of trouble, and of rebuke, and of rejection; for the children have come to the birth, and there is no strength to give birth. ⁴It may be the LORD your God will hear the words

of Rabshakeh, whom the king of Assyria his master has sent to defy the living God, and will rebuke the words which the LORD your God has heard. Therefore lift up your prayer for the remnant that is left.”⁵ So the servants of King Hezekiah came to Isaiah. ⁶Isaiah said to them, “Tell your master, ‘The LORD says, “Don’t be afraid of the words that you have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me. ⁷Behold, I will put a spirit in him and he will hear news, and will return to his own land. I will cause him to fall by the sword in his own land.”’” ⁸So Rabshakeh returned, and found the king of Assyria warring against Libnah, for he heard that he had departed from Lachish. ⁹He heard news concerning Tirhakah king of Ethiopia, “He has come out to fight against you.” When he heard it, he sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying, ¹⁰“Thus you shall speak to Hezekiah king of Judah, saying, ‘Don’t let your God in whom you trust deceive you, saying, “Jerusalem won’t be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.” ¹¹Behold, you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by destroying them utterly. Shall you be delivered? ¹²Have the gods of the nations delivered them, which my fathers have destroyed, Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the children of Eden who were in Telassar? ¹³Where is the king of Hamath, and the king of Arpad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah?’” ¹⁴Hezekiah received the letter from the hand of the messengers and read it. Then Hezekiah went up to the LORD’s house, and spread it before the LORD. ¹⁵Hezekiah prayed to the LORD, saying, ¹⁶“LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, who is enthroned among the cherubim, you are the God, even you alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth. You have made heaven and earth. ¹⁷Turn your ear, LORD, and hear. Open your eyes, LORD, and behold. Hear all of the words of Sennacherib, who has sent to defy the living God. ¹⁸Truly, LORD, the kings of Assyria have destroyed all the countries and their land, ¹⁹and have cast their gods into the fire; for they were no gods, but the work of men’s hands, wood and stone; therefore they have destroyed them. ²⁰Now therefore, LORD our God, save us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that you are the LORD, even you only.” ²¹Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to Hezekiah, saying, “The LORD, the God of Israel says, ‘Because you have prayed to me against Sennacherib king of Assyria, ²²this is the word which the LORD has spoken concerning him: The virgin daughter of Zion has despised you and ridiculed you. The daughter of Jerusalem has shaken her head at you. ²³Whom have you defied and blasphemed? Against whom have you exalted your voice and lifted up your eyes on high? Against the Holy One of Israel. ²⁴By your servants, you have defied the Lord, and have said, “With the multitude of my chariots I have come up to the height of the mountains, to the innermost parts of Lebanon. I will cut down its tall cedars and its choice

cypress trees. I will enter into its farthest height, the forest of its fruitful field. ²⁵I have dug and drunk water, and with the sole of my feet I will dry up all the rivers of Egypt.” ²⁶“Have you not heard how I have done it long ago, and formed it in ancient times? Now I have brought it to pass, that it should be yours to destroy fortified cities, turning them into ruinous heaps. ²⁷Therefore their inhabitants had little power. They were dismayed and confounded. They were like the grass of the field, and like the green herb, like the grass on the housetops, and like a field before its crop has grown. ²⁸But I know your sitting down, your going out, your coming in, and your raging against me. ²⁹Because of your raging against me, and because your arrogance has come up into my ears, therefore I will put my hook in your nose and my bridle in your lips, and I will turn you back by the way by which you came. ³⁰“This shall be the sign to you: You will eat this year that which grows of itself, and in the second year that which springs from it; and in the third year sow and reap and plant vineyards, and eat their fruit. ³¹The remnant that is escaped of the house of Judah will again take root downward, and bear fruit upward. ³²For out of Jerusalem a remnant will go out, and survivors will escape from Mount Zion. The zeal of the LORD of Hosts will perform this.’ ³³“Therefore the LORD says concerning the king of Assyria, ‘He will not come to this city, nor shoot an arrow there, neither will he come before it with shield, nor cast up a mound against it. ³⁴He will return the way that he came, and he won’t come to this city,’ says the LORD. ³⁵“For I will defend this city to save it, for my own sake, and for my servant David’s sake.” ³⁶Then the LORD’s angel went out and struck one hundred and eighty-five thousand men in the camp of the Assyrians. When men arose early in the morning, behold, these were all dead bodies. ³⁷So Sennacherib king of Assyria departed, went away, returned to Nineveh, and stayed there. ³⁸As he was worshiping in the house of Nisroch his god, Adrammelech and Sharezer his sons struck him with the sword; and they escaped into the land of Ararat. Esar Haddon his son reigned in his place.

38In those days Hezekiah was sick and near death. Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, came to him, and said to him, “The LORD says, ‘Set your house in order, for you will die, and not live.’” ²Then Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD, ³and said, “Remember now, the LORD, I beg you, how I have walked before you in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in your sight.” Then Hezekiah wept bitterly. ⁴Then the LORD’s word came to Isaiah, saying, ⁵“Go, and tell Hezekiah, ‘The LORD, the God of David your father, says, “I have heard your prayer. I have seen your tears. Behold, I will add fifteen years to your life. ⁶I will deliver you and this city out of the hand of the king of Assyria, and I will defend this city. ⁷This shall be the sign to you

from the LORD, that the LORD will do this thing that he has spoken. ⁸Behold, I will cause the shadow on the sundial, which has gone down on the sundial of Ahaz with the sun, to return backward ten steps.”” So the sun returned ten steps on the sundial on which it had gone down. ⁹The writing of Hezekiah king of Judah, when he had been sick, and had recovered of his sickness: ¹⁰I said, “In the middle of my life I go into the gates of Sheol. ^{xxiii} I am deprived of the residue of my years.” ¹¹I said, “I won’t see the LORD, The LORD in the land of the living. I will see man no more with the inhabitants of the world. ¹²My dwelling is removed, and is carried away from me like a shepherd’s tent. I have rolled up my life like a weaver. He will cut me off from the loom. From day even to night you will make an end of me. ¹³I waited patiently until morning. He breaks all my bones like a lion. From day even to night you will make an end of me. ¹⁴I chattered like a swallow or a crane. I moaned like a dove. My eyes weaken looking upward. Lord, I am oppressed. Be my security.” ¹⁵What will I say? He has both spoken to me, and himself has done it. I will walk carefully all my years because of the anguish of my soul. ¹⁶Lord, men live by these things; and my spirit finds life in all of them. You restore me, and cause me to live. ¹⁷Behold, for peace I had great anguish, but you have in love for my soul delivered it from the pit of corruption; for you have cast all my sins behind your back. ¹⁸For Sheol ^{xxiv} can’t praise you. Death can’t celebrate you. Those who go down into the pit can’t hope for your truth. ¹⁹The living, the living, he shall praise you, as I do today. The father shall make known your truth to the children. ²⁰The LORD will save me. Therefore we will sing my songs with stringed instruments all the days of our life in the LORD’s house. ²¹Now Isaiah had said, “Let them take a cake of figs, and lay it for a poultice on the boil, and he shall recover.” ²²Hezekiah also had said, “What is the sign that I will go up to the LORD’s house?”

39At that time, Merodach-baladan the son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent letters and a present to Hezekiah, for he heard that he had been sick, and had recovered. ²Hezekiah was pleased with them, and showed them the house of his precious things, the silver, the gold, the spices, and the precious oil, and all the house of his armor, and all that was found in his treasures. There was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah didn’t show them. ³Then Isaiah the prophet came to King Hezekiah, and asked him, “What did these men say? From where did they come to you?” Hezekiah said, “They have come from a country far from me, even from Babylon.” ⁴Then he asked, “What have they seen in your house?” Hezekiah answered, “They have seen all that is in my house. There is nothing among my treasures that I have not shown

them.” ⁵Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, “Hear the word of the LORD of Hosts: ⁶Behold, the days are coming when all that is in your house, and that which your fathers have stored up until today, will be carried to Babylon. Nothing will be left,” says the LORD. ⁷“They will take away your sons who will issue from you, whom you shall father, and they will be eunuchs in the king of Babylon’s palace.” ⁸Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah, “The LORD’s word which you have spoken is good.” He said moreover, “For there will be peace and truth in my days.”

40“Comfort, comfort my people,” says your God. ²“Speak comfortably to Jerusalem, and call out to her that her warfare is accomplished, that her iniquity is pardoned, that she has received of the LORD’s hand double for all her sins.” ³The voice of one who calls out, “Prepare the way of the LORD in the wilderness! Make a level highway in the desert for our God. ⁴Every valley shall be exalted, and every mountain and hill shall be made low. The uneven shall be made level, and the rough places a plain. ⁵The LORD’s glory shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together; for the mouth of the LORD has spoken it.” ⁶The voice of one saying, “Cry out!” One said, “What shall I cry?” “All flesh is like grass, and all its glory is like the flower of the field. ⁷The grass withers, the flower fades, because the LORD’s breath blows on it. Surely the people are like grass. ⁸The grass withers, the flower fades; but the word of our God stands forever.” ⁹You who tell good news to Zion, go up on a high mountain. You who tell good news to Jerusalem, lift up your voice with strength! Lift it up! Don’t be afraid! Say to the cities of Judah, “Behold, your God!” ¹⁰Behold, the Lord GOD will come as a mighty one, and his arm will rule for him. Behold, his reward is with him, and his recompense before him. ¹¹He will feed his flock like a shepherd. He will gather the lambs in his arm, and carry them in his bosom. He will gently lead those who have their young. ¹²Who has measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, and marked off the sky with his span, and calculated the dust of the earth in a measuring basket, and weighed the mountains in scales, and the hills in a balance? ¹³Who has directed the LORD’s Spirit, or has taught him as his counselor? ¹⁴Who did he take counsel with, and who instructed him, and taught him in the path of justice, and taught him knowledge, and showed him the way of understanding? ¹⁵Behold, the nations are like a drop in a bucket, and are regarded as a speck of dust on a balance. Behold, he lifts up the islands like a very little thing. ¹⁶Lebanon is not sufficient to burn, nor its animals sufficient for a burnt offering. ¹⁷All the nations are like nothing before him. They are regarded by him as less than nothing, and vanity. ¹⁸To whom then will you liken God? Or what likeness will you compare to him? ¹⁹A workman has cast an image, and the goldsmith overlays it with gold, and casts silver chains for it. ²⁰He who is too

^{xxiii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xxiv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

impoverished for such an offering chooses a tree that will not rot. He seeks a skillful workman to set up a carved image for him that will not be moved. ²¹Haven't you known? Haven't you heard? Haven't you been told from the beginning? Haven't you understood from the foundations of the earth? ²²It is he who sits above the circle of the earth, and its inhabitants are like grasshoppers; who stretches out the heavens like a curtain, and spreads them out like a tent to dwell in, ²³who brings princes to nothing, who makes the judges of the earth meaningless. ²⁴They are planted scarcely. They are sown scarcely. Their stock has scarcely taken root in the ground. He merely blows on them, and they wither, and the whirlwind takes them away as stubble. ²⁵"To whom then will you liken me? Who is my equal?" says the Holy One. ²⁶Lift up your eyes on high, and see who has created these, who brings out their army by number. He calls them all by name. by the greatness of his might, and because he is strong in power, not one is lacking. ²⁷Why do you say, Jacob, and speak, Israel, "My way is hidden from the LORD, and the justice due me is disregarded by my God?" ²⁸Haven't you known? Haven't you heard? The everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth, doesn't faint. He isn't weary. His understanding is unsearchable. ²⁹He gives power to the weak. He increases the strength of him who has no might. ³⁰Even the youths faint and get weary, and the young men utterly fall; ³¹but those who wait for the LORD will renew their strength. They will mount up with wings like eagles. They will run, and not be weary. They will walk, and not faint.

⁴¹"Keep silent before me, islands, and let the peoples renew their strength. Let them come near, then let them speak. Let's meet together for judgment. ²Who has raised up one from the east? Who called him to his feet in righteousness? He hands over nations to him and makes him rule over kings. He gives them like the dust to his sword, like the driven stubble to his bow. ³He pursues them and passes by safely, even by a way that he had not gone with his feet. ⁴Who has worked and done it, calling the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD, the first, and with the last, I am he." ⁵The islands have seen, and fear. The ends of the earth tremble. They approach, and come. ⁶Everyone helps his neighbor. They say to their brothers, "Be strong!" ⁷So the carpenter encourages the goldsmith. He who smooths with the hammer encourages him who strikes the anvil, saying of the soldering, "It is good;" and he fastens it with nails, that it might not totter. ⁸"But you, Israel, my servant, Jacob whom I have chosen, the offspring of Abraham my friend, ⁹you whom I have taken hold of from the ends of the earth, and called from its corners, and said to you, 'You are my servant. I have chosen you and have not cast you away.' ¹⁰Don't you be afraid, for I am with you. Don't be dismayed, for I am

your God. I will strengthen you. Yes, I will help you. Yes, I will uphold you with the right hand of my righteousness. ¹¹Behold, all those who are incensed against you will be disappointed and confounded. Those who strive with you will be like nothing, and shall perish. ¹²You will seek them, and won't find them, even those who contend with you. Those who war against you will be as nothing, as a nonexistent thing. ¹³For I, the LORD your God, will hold your right hand, saying to you, 'Don't be afraid. I will help you.' ¹⁴Don't be afraid, you worm Jacob, and you men of Israel. I will help you," says the LORD. "Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel. ¹⁵Behold, I have made you into a new sharp threshing instrument with teeth. You will thresh the mountains, and beat them small, and will make the hills like chaff. ¹⁶You will winnow them, and the wind will carry them away, and the whirlwind will scatter them. You will rejoice in the LORD. You will glory in the Holy One of Israel. ¹⁷The poor and needy seek water, and there is none. Their tongue fails for thirst. I, the LORD, will answer them. I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them. ¹⁸I will open rivers on the bare heights, and springs in the middle of the valleys. I will make the wilderness a pool of water, and the dry land springs of water. ¹⁹I will put cedar, acacia, myrtle, and oil trees in the wilderness. I will set cypress trees, pine, and box trees together in the desert; ²⁰that they may see, know, consider, and understand together, that the LORD's hand has done this, and the Holy One of Israel has created it. ²¹Produce your cause," says the LORD. "Bring out your strong reasons!" says the King of Jacob. ²²"Let them announce and declare to us what will happen! Declare the former things, what they are, that we may consider them, and know the latter end of them; or show us things to come. ²³Declare the things that are to come hereafter, that we may know that you are gods. Yes, do good, or do evil, that we may be dismayed, and see it together. ²⁴Behold, you are nothing, and your work is nothing. He who chooses you is an abomination. ²⁵"I have raised up one from the north, and he has come, from the rising of the sun, one who calls on my name, and he shall come on rulers as on mortar, and as the potter treads clay. ²⁶Who has declared it from the beginning, that we may know? and before, that we may say, 'He is right?' Surely, there is no one who declares. Surely, there is no one who shows. Surely, there is no one who hears your words. ²⁷I am the first to say to Zion, 'Behold, look at them;' and I will give one who brings good news to Jerusalem. ²⁸When I look, there is no man, even among them there is no counselor who, when I ask, can answer a word. ²⁹Behold, all of their deeds are vanity and nothing. Their molten images are wind and confusion.

⁴²"Behold, my servant, whom I uphold, my chosen, in whom my soul delights: I have put my Spirit on him. He will bring justice to the nations. ²He will not shout,

nor raise his voice, nor cause it to be heard in the street. ³He won't break a bruised reed. He won't quench a dimly burning wick. He will faithfully bring justice. ⁴He will not fail nor be discouraged, until he has set justice in the earth, and the islands wait for his law." ⁵God the LORD, he who created the heavens and stretched them out, he who spread out the earth and that which comes out of it, he who gives breath to its people and spirit to those who walk in it, says: ⁶"I, the LORD, have called you in righteousness. I will hold your hand. I will keep you, and make you a covenant for the people, as a light for the nations, ⁷to open the blind eyes, to bring the prisoners out of the dungeon, and those who sit in darkness out of the prison. ⁸"I am the LORD. That is my name. I will not give my glory to another, nor my praise to engraved images. ⁹Behold, the former things have happened and I declare new things. I tell you about them before they come up." ¹⁰Sing to the LORD a new song, and his praise from the end of the earth, you who go down to the sea, and all that is therein, the islands and their inhabitants. ¹¹Let the wilderness and its cities raise their voices, with the villages that Kedar inhabits. Let the inhabitants of Sela sing. Let them shout from the top of the mountains! ¹²Let them give glory to the LORD, and declare his praise in the islands. ¹³The LORD will go out like a mighty man. He will stir up zeal like a man of war. He will raise a war cry. Yes, he will shout aloud. He will triumph over his enemies. ¹⁴"I have been silent a long time. I have been quiet and restrained myself. Now I will cry out like a travailing woman. I will both gasp and pant. ¹⁵I will destroy mountains and hills, and dry up all their herbs. I will make the rivers islands, and will dry up the pools. ¹⁶I will bring the blind by a way that they don't know. I will lead them in paths that they don't know. I will make darkness light before them, and crooked places straight. I will do these things, and I will not forsake them. ¹⁷"Those who trust in engraved images, who tell molten images, 'You are our gods,' will be turned back. They will be utterly disappointed. ¹⁸"Hear, you deaf, and look, you blind, that you may see. ¹⁹Who is blind, but my servant? Or who is as deaf as my messenger whom I send? Who is as blind as he who is at peace, and as blind as the LORD's servant? ²⁰You see many things, but don't observe. His ears are open, but he doesn't listen. ²¹It pleased the LORD, for his righteousness' sake, to magnify the law and make it honorable. ²²But this is a robbed and plundered people. All of them are snared in holes, and they are hidden in prisons. They have become captives, and no one delivers, and a plunder, and no one says, 'Restore them!' ²³Who is there among you who will give ear to this? Who will listen and hear for the time to come? ²⁴Who gave Jacob as plunder, and Israel to the robbers? Didn't the LORD, he against whom we have sinned? For they would not walk in his ways, and they disobeyed his law. ²⁵Therefore he poured the fierceness of his anger on him, and the strength

of battle. It set him on fire all around, but he didn't know. It burned him, but he didn't take it to heart."

43But now the LORD who created you, Jacob, and he who formed you, Israel, says: "Don't be afraid, for I have redeemed you. I have called you by your name. You are mine. ²When you pass through the waters, I will be with you, and through the rivers, they will not overflow you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be burned, and flame will not scorch you. ³For I am the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, your Savior. I have given Egypt as your ransom, Ethiopia and Seba in your place. ⁴Since you have been precious and honored in my sight, and I have loved you, therefore I will give people in your place, and nations instead of your life. ⁵Don't be afraid, for I am with you. I will bring your offspring from the east, and gather you from the west. ⁶I will tell the north, 'Give them up!' and tell the south, 'Don't hold them back! Bring my sons from far away, and my daughters from the ends of the earth— ⁷everyone who is called by my name, and whom I have created for my glory, whom I have formed, yes, whom I have made.'" ⁸Bring out the blind people who have eyes, and the deaf who have ears. ⁹Let all the nations be gathered together, and let the peoples be assembled. Who among them can declare this, and show us former things? Let them bring their witnesses, that they may be justified, or let them hear, and say, "That is true." ¹⁰"You are my witnesses," says the LORD, "With my servant whom I have chosen; that you may know and believe me, and understand that I am he. Before me there was no God formed, neither will there be after me. ¹¹I myself am the LORD. Besides me, there is no savior. ¹²I have declared, I have saved, and I have shown, and there was no strange god among you. Therefore you are my witnesses", says the LORD, "and I am God. ¹³Yes, since the day was, I am he. There is no one who can deliver out of my hand. I will work, and who can hinder it?" ¹⁴The LORD, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel says: "For your sake, I have sent to Babylon, and I will bring all of them down as fugitives, even the Kasdim, in the ships of their rejoicing. ¹⁵I am the LORD, your Holy One, the Creator of Israel, your King." ¹⁶The LORD, who makes a way in the sea, and a path in the mighty waters, ¹⁷who brings out the chariot and horse, the army and the mighty man (they lie down together, they shall not rise; they are extinct, they are quenched like a wick) says: ¹⁸"Don't remember the former things, and don't consider the things of old. ¹⁹Behold, I will do a new thing. It springs out now. Don't you know it? I will even make a way in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert. ²⁰The animals of the field, the jackals and the ostriches, shall honor me, because I give water in the wilderness and rivers in the desert, to give drink to my people, my chosen, ²¹the people which I formed for myself, that they might declare my praise. ²²Yet you have not

called on me, Jacob; but you have been weary of me, Israel. ²³You have not brought me any of your sheep for burnt offerings, neither have you honored me with your sacrifices. I have not burdened you with offerings, nor wearied you with frankincense. ²⁴You have bought me no sweet cane with money, nor have you filled me with the fat of your sacrifices, but you have burdened me with your sins. You have wearied me with your iniquities. ²⁵I, even I, am he who blots out your transgressions for my own sake; and I will not remember your sins. ²⁶Put me in remembrance. Let us plead together. Declare your case, that you may be justified. ²⁷Your first father sinned, and your teachers have transgressed against me. ²⁸Therefore I will profane the princes of the sanctuary; and I will make Jacob a curse, and Israel an insult."

44Yet listen now, Jacob my servant, and Israel, whom I have chosen. ²This is what the LORD who made you, and formed you from the womb, who will help you says: "Don't be afraid, Jacob my servant; and you, Jeshurun, whom I have chosen. ³For I will pour water on him who is thirsty, and streams on the dry ground. I will pour my Spirit on your descendants, and my blessing on your offspring; ⁴and they will spring up among the grass, as willows by the watercourses. ⁵One will say, 'I am the LORD's.' Another will be called by the name of Jacob; and another will write with his hand 'to the LORD,' and honor the name of Israel." ⁶This is what the LORD, the King of Israel, and his Redeemer, the LORD of Hosts, says: "I am the first, and I am the last; and besides me there is no God. ⁷Who is like me? Who will call, and will declare it, and set it in order for me, since I established the ancient people? Let them declare the things that are coming, and that will happen. ⁸Don't fear, neither be afraid. Haven't I declared it to you long ago, and shown it? You are my witnesses. Is there a God besides me? Indeed, there is not. I don't know any other Rock." ⁹Everyone who makes a carved image is vain. The things that they delight in will not profit. Their own witnesses don't see, nor know, that they may be disappointed. ¹⁰Who has fashioned a god, or molds an image that is profitable for nothing? ¹¹Behold, all his fellows will be disappointed; and the workmen are mere men. Let them all be gathered together. Let them stand up. They will fear. They will be put to shame together. ¹²The blacksmith takes an ax, works in the coals, fashions it with hammers, and works it with his strong arm. He is hungry, and his strength fails; he drinks no water, and is faint. ¹³The carpenter stretches out a line. He marks it out with a pencil. He shapes it with planes. He marks it out with compasses, and shapes it like the figure of a man, with the beauty of a man, to reside in a house. ¹⁴He cuts down cedars for himself, and takes the cypress and the oak, and strengthens for himself one among the trees of the forest. He plants a cypress tree, and the rain nour-

ishes it. ¹⁵Then it will be for a man to burn; and he takes some of it and warms himself. Yes, he burns it and bakes bread. Yes, he makes a god and worships it; he makes it a carved image, and falls down to it. ¹⁶He burns part of it in the fire. With part of it, he eats meat. He roasts a roast and is satisfied. Yes, he warms himself and says, "Aha! I am warm. I have seen the fire." ¹⁷The rest of it he makes into a god, even his engraved image. He bows down to it and worships, and prays to it, and says, "Deliver me, for you are my god!" ¹⁸They don't know, neither do they consider, for he has shut their eyes, that they can't see, and their hearts, that they can't understand. ¹⁹No one thinks, neither is there knowledge nor understanding to say, "I have burned part of it in the fire. Yes, I have also baked bread on its coals. I have roasted meat and eaten it. Shall I make the rest of it into an abomination? Shall I bow down to a tree trunk?" ²⁰He feeds on ashes. A deceived heart has turned him aside; and he can't deliver his soul, nor say, "Isn't there a lie in my right hand?" ²¹Remember these things, Jacob and Israel, for you are my servant. I have formed you. You are my servant. Israel, you will not be forgotten by me. ²²I have blotted out, as a thick cloud, your transgressions, and, as a cloud, your sins. Return to me, for I have redeemed you. ²³Sing, you heavens, for the LORD has done it! Shout, you lower parts of the earth! Break out into singing, you mountains, O forest, all of your trees, for the LORD has redeemed Jacob, and will glorify himself in Israel. ²⁴The LORD, your Redeemer, and he who formed you from the womb says: "I am the LORD, who makes all things; who alone stretches out the heavens; who spreads out the earth by myself; ²⁵who frustrates the signs of the liars, and makes diviners mad; who turns wise men backward, and makes their knowledge foolish; ²⁶who confirms the word of his servant, and performs the counsel of his messengers; who says of Jerusalem, 'She will be inhabited;' and of the cities of Judah, 'They will be built,' and 'I will raise up its waste places;' ²⁷who says to the deep, 'Be dry,' and 'I will dry up your rivers,' ²⁸who says of Cyrus, 'He is my shepherd, and shall perform all my pleasure,' even saying of Jerusalem, 'She will be built;' and of the temple, 'Your foundation will be laid.'"

45The LORD says to his anointed, to Cyrus, whose right hand I have held to subdue nations before him and strip kings of their armor, to open the doors before him, and the gates shall not be shut: ²"I will go before you and make the rough places smooth. I will break the doors of bronze in pieces and cut apart the bars of iron. ³I will give you the treasures of darkness and hidden riches of secret places, that you may know that it is I, the LORD, who calls you by your name, even the God of Israel. ⁴For Jacob my servant's sake, and Israel my chosen, I have called you by your name. I have given you a title, though you have not known me. ⁵I am the LORD, and there is no

one else. Besides me, there is no God. I will strengthen^{xxv} you, though you have not known me, ⁶that they may know from the rising of the sun, and from the west, that there is no one besides me. I am the LORD, and there is no one else. ⁷I form the light and create darkness. I make peace and create calamity. I am the LORD, who does all these things. ⁸Rain, you heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness. Let the earth open, that it may produce salvation, and let it cause righteousness to spring up with it. I, the LORD, have created it. ⁹Woe to him who strives with his Maker— a clay pot among the clay pots of the earth! Shall the clay ask him who fashions it, ‘What are you making?’ or your work, ‘He has no hands?’ ¹⁰Woe to him who says to a father, ‘What have you become the father of?’ or to a mother, ‘What have you given birth to?’” ¹¹The LORD, the Holy One of Israel and his Maker says: “You ask me about the things that are to come, concerning my sons, and you command me concerning the work of my hands! ¹²I have made the earth, and created man on it. I, even my hands, have stretched out the heavens. I have commanded all their army. ¹³I have raised him up in righteousness, and I will make all his ways straight. He shall build my city, and he shall let my exiles go free, not for price nor reward,” says the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁴The LORD says: “The labor of Egypt, and the merchandise of Ethiopia, and the Sabeans, men of stature, will come over to you, and they will be yours. They will go after you. They shall come over in chains. They will bow down to you. They will make supplication to you: ‘Surely God is in you; and there is no one else. There is no other god. ¹⁵Most certainly you are a God who has hidden yourself, God of Israel, the Savior.’” ¹⁶They will be disappointed, yes, confounded, all of them. Those who are makers of idols will go into confusion together. ¹⁷Israel will be saved by the LORD with an everlasting salvation. You will not be disappointed nor confounded to ages everlasting. ¹⁸For the LORD who created the heavens, the God who formed the earth and made it, who established it and didn’t create it a waste, who formed it to be inhabited says: “I am the LORD. There is no other. ¹⁹I have not spoken in secret, in a place of the land of darkness. I didn’t say to the offspring of Jacob, ‘Seek me in vain.’ I, the LORD, speak righteousness. I declare things that are right. ²⁰“Assemble yourselves and come. Draw near together, you who have escaped from the nations. Those have no knowledge who carry the wood of their engraved image, and pray to a god that can’t save. ²¹Declare and present it. Yes, let them take counsel together. Who has shown this from ancient time? Who has declared it of old? Haven’t I, the LORD? There is no other God besides me, a just God and a Savior. There is no one besides me. ²²“Look to me, and be saved, all the ends of the earth; for I am God, and there is no other. ²³I have sworn by myself.

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The word has gone out of my mouth in righteousness, and will not be revoked, that to me every knee shall bow, every tongue shall take an oath. ²⁴They will say of me, ‘There is righteousness and strength only in the LORD.’” Even to him will men come. All those who raged against him will be disappointed. ²⁵All the offspring of Israel will be justified in the LORD, and will rejoice!

46Bel bows down. Nebo stoops. Their idols are carried by animals, and on the livestock. The things that you carried around are heavy loads, a burden for the weary. ²They stoop and they bow down together. They could not deliver the burden, but they have gone into captivity. ³“Listen to me, house of Jacob, and all the remnant of the house of Israel, that have been carried from their birth, that have been carried from the womb. ⁴Even to old age I am he, and even to gray hairs I will carry you. I have made, and I will bear. Yes, I will carry, and will deliver. ⁵“To whom will you compare me, and consider my equal, and compare me, as if we were the same? ⁶Some pour out gold from the bag, and weigh silver in the balance. They hire a goldsmith, and he makes it a god. They fall down—yes, they worship. ⁷They bear it on their shoulder. They carry it, and set it in its place, and it stands there. It cannot move from its place. Yes, one may cry to it, yet it can not answer. It cannot save him out of his trouble. ⁸“Remember this, and show yourselves men. Bring it to mind again, you transgressors. ⁹Remember the former things of old; for I am God, and there is no other. I am God, and there is none like me. ¹⁰I declare the end from the beginning, and from ancient times things that are not yet done. I say: My counsel will stand, and I will do all that I please. ¹¹I call a ravenous bird from the east, the man of my counsel from a far country. Yes, I have spoken. I will also bring it to pass. I have planned. I will also do it. ¹²Listen to me, you stubborn-hearted, who are far from righteousness! ¹³I bring my righteousness near. It is not far off, and my salvation will not wait. I will grant salvation to Zion, my glory to Israel.

47“Come down and sit in the dust, virgin daughter of Babylon. Sit on the ground without a throne, daughter of the Kasdim. For you will no longer be called tender and delicate. ²Take the millstones and grind flour. Remove your veil, lift up your skirt, uncover your legs, and wade through the rivers. ³Your nakedness will be uncovered. Yes, your shame will be seen. I will take vengeance, and will spare no one.” ⁴Our Redeemer, the LORD of Hosts is his name, is the Holy One of Israel. ⁵“Sit in silence, and go into darkness, daughter of the Kasdim. For you shall no longer be called the mistress of kingdoms. ⁶I was angry with my people. I profaned my inheritance and gave them into your hand. You showed them no mercy. You laid a very heavy yoke on the aged. ⁷You said, ‘I will be a

princess forever,' so that you didn't lay these things to your heart, nor did you remember the results. ⁸"Now therefore hear this, you who are given to pleasures, who sit securely, who say in your heart, 'I am, and there is no one else besides me. I won't sit as a widow, neither will I know the loss of children.' ⁹But these two things will come to you in a moment in one day: the loss of children and widowhood. They will come on you in their full measure, in the multitude of your sorceries, and the great abundance of your enchantments. ¹⁰For you have trusted in your wickedness. You have said, 'No one sees me.' Your wisdom and your knowledge has perverted you. You have said in your heart, 'I am, and there is no one else besides me.' ¹¹Therefore disaster will come on you. You won't know when it dawns. Mischief will fall on you. You won't be able to put it away. Desolation will come on you suddenly, which you don't understand. ¹²"Stand now with your enchantments and with the multitude of your sorceries, in which you have labored from your youth, as if you might profit, as if you might prevail. ¹³You are wearied in the multitude of your counsels. Now let the astrologers, the stargazers, and the monthly prognosticators stand up and save you from the things that will happen to you. ¹⁴Behold, they are like stubble. The fire will burn them. They won't deliver themselves from the power of the flame. It won't be a coal to warm at or a fire to sit by. ¹⁵The things that you labored in will be like this: those who have trafficked with you from your youth will each wander in his own way. There will be no one to save you.

48"Hear this, house of Jacob, you who are called by the name of Israel, and have come out of the waters of Judah. You swear by the LORD's name, and make mention of the God of Israel, but not in truth, nor in righteousness—²for they call themselves citizens of the holy city, and rely on the God of Israel; the LORD of Hosts is his name. ³I have declared the former things from of old. Yes, they went out of my mouth, and I revealed them. I did them suddenly, and they happened. ⁴Because I knew that you are obstinate, and your neck is an iron sinew, and your brow bronze; ⁵therefore I have declared it to you from of old; before it came to pass I showed it to you; lest you should say, 'My idol has done them. My engraved image and my molten image has commanded them.' ⁶You have heard it. Now see all this. And you, won't you declare it? 'I have shown you new things from this time, even hidden things, which you have not known. ⁷They are created now, and not from of old. Before today, you didn't hear them, lest you should say, 'Behold, I knew them.' ⁸Yes, you didn't hear. Yes, you didn't know. Yes, from of old your ear was not opened, for I knew that you dealt very treacherously, and were called a transgressor from the womb. ⁹For my name's sake, I will defer my anger, and for my praise, I hold it back for you so that I don't cut you off. ¹⁰Behold, I

have refined you, but not as silver. I have chosen you in the furnace of affliction. ¹¹For my own sake, for my own sake, I will do it; for how would my name be profaned? I will not give my glory to another. ¹²"Listen to me, O Jacob, and Israel my called: I am he. I am the first. I am also the last. ¹³Yes, my hand has laid the foundation of the earth, and my right hand has spread out the heavens. when I call to them, they stand up together. ¹⁴"Assemble yourselves, all of you, and hear! Who among them has declared these things? He whom the LORD loves will do what he likes to Babylon, and his arm will be against the Kasdim. ¹⁵I, even I, have spoken. Yes, I have called him. I have brought him and he shall make his way prosperous. ¹⁶"Come near to me and hear this: "From the beginning I have not spoken in secret; from the time that it happened, I was there." Now the Lord GOD has sent me with his Spirit. ¹⁷The LORD, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel, says: "I am the LORD your God, who teaches you to profit, who leads you by the way that you should go. ¹⁸Oh that you had listened to my commandments! Then your peace would have been like a river and your righteousness like the waves of the sea. ¹⁹Your offspring also would have been as the sand and the descendants of your body like its grains. His name would not be cut off nor destroyed from before me." ²⁰Leave Babylon! Flee from the Kasdim! With a voice of singing announce this, tell it even to the end of the earth; say, "The LORD has redeemed his servant Jacob!" ²¹They didn't thirst when he led them through the deserts. He caused the waters to flow out of the rock for them. He also split the rock and the waters gushed out. ²²"There is no peace", says the LORD, "for the wicked."

49Listen, islands, to me. Listen, you peoples, from afar: the LORD has called me from the womb; from the inside of my mother, he has mentioned my name. ²He has made my mouth like a sharp sword. He has hidden me in the shadow of his hand. He has made me a polished shaft. He has kept me close in his quiver. ³He said to me, "You are my servant, Israel, in whom I will be glorified." ⁴But I said, "I have labored in vain. I have spent my strength in vain for nothing; yet surely the justice due to me is with the LORD, and my reward with my God." ⁵Now the LORD, he who formed me from the womb to be his servant, says to bring Jacob again to him, and to gather Israel to him, for I am honorable in the LORD's eyes, and my God has become my strength. ⁶Indeed, he says, "It is too light a thing that you should be my servant to raise up the tribes of Jacob, and to restore the preserved of Israel. I will also give you as a light to the nations, that you may be my salvation to the end of the earth." ⁷The LORD, the Redeemer of Israel, and his Holy One, says to him whom man despises, to him whom the nation abhors, to a servant of rulers: "Kings shall see and rise up, princes, and they shall worship, because of the LORD who is faithful,

even the Holy One of Israel, who has chosen you.” ⁸The LORD says, “I have answered you in an acceptable time. I have helped you in a day of salvation. I will preserve you and give you for a covenant of the people, to raise up the land, to make them inherit the desolate heritage, ⁹saying to those who are bound, ‘Come out!’; to those who are in darkness, ‘Show yourselves!’ “They shall feed along the paths, and their pasture shall be on all treeless heights. ¹⁰They shall not hunger nor thirst; neither shall the heat nor sun strike them, for he who has mercy on them will lead them. He will guide them by springs of water. ¹¹I will make all my mountains a road, and my highways shall be exalted. ¹²Behold, these shall come from afar, and behold, these from the north and from the west, and these from the land of Sinim.” ¹³Sing, heavens, and be joyful, earth! Break out into singing, mountains! For the LORD has comforted his people, and will have compassion on his afflicted. ¹⁴But Zion said, “The LORD has forsaken me, and the Lord has forgotten me.” ¹⁵“Can a woman forget her nursing child, that she should not have compassion on the son of her womb? Yes, these may forget, yet I will not forget you! ¹⁶Behold, I have engraved you on the palms of my hands. Your walls are continually before me. ¹⁷Your children hurry. Your destroyers and those who devastated you will leave you. ¹⁸Lift up your eyes all around, and see: all these gather themselves together, and come to you. As I live,” says the LORD, “you shall surely clothe yourself with them all as with an ornament, and dress yourself with them, like a bride. ¹⁹“For, as for your waste and your desolate places, and your land that has been destroyed, surely now that land will be too small for the inhabitants, and those who swallowed you up will be far away. ²⁰The children of your bereavement will say in your ears, ‘This place is too small for me. Give me a place to live in.’ ²¹Then you will say in your heart, ‘Who has conceived these for me, since I have been bereaved of my children and am alone, an exile, and wandering back and forth? Who has brought these up? Behold, I was left alone. Where were these?’” ²²The Lord GOD says, “Behold, I will lift up my hand to the nations, and lift up my banner to the peoples. They shall bring your sons in their bosom, and your daughters shall be carried on their shoulders. ²³Kings shall be your foster fathers, and their queens your nursing mothers. They will bow down to you with their faces to the earth, and lick the dust of your feet. Then you will know that I am the LORD; and those who wait for me won’t be disappointed.” ²⁴Shall the plunder be taken from the mighty, or the lawful captives be delivered? ²⁵But the LORD says, “Even the captives of the mighty shall be taken away, and the plunder retrieved from the fierce, for I will contend with him who contends with you and I will save your children. ²⁶I will feed those who oppress you with their own flesh; and they will be drunk on their own blood, as with sweet wine. Then all

flesh shall know that I, the LORD, am your Savior and your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob.”

50The LORD says, “Where is the bill of your mother’s divorce, with which I have put her away? Or to which of my creditors have I sold you? Behold, you were sold for your iniquities, and your mother was put away for your transgressions. ²Why, when I came, was there no one? When I called, why was there no one to answer? Is my hand shortened at all, that it can’t redeem? Or have I no power to deliver? Behold, at my rebuke I dry up the sea. I make the rivers a wilderness. Their fish stink because there is no water, and die of thirst. ³I clothe the heavens with blackness. I make sackcloth their covering.” ⁴The Lord GOD has given me the tongue of those who are taught, that I may know how to sustain with words him who is weary. He awakens morning by morning, he awakens my ear to hear as those who are taught. ⁵The Lord GOD has opened my ear. I was not rebellious. I have not turned back. ⁶I gave my back to those who beat me, and my cheeks to those who plucked off the hair. I didn’t hide my face from shame and spitting. ⁷For the Lord GOD will help me. Therefore I have not been confounded. Therefore I have set my face like a flint, and I know that I won’t be disappointed. ⁸He who justifies me is near. Who will bring charges against me? Let us stand up together. Who is my adversary? Let him come near to me. ⁹Behold, the Lord GOD will help me! Who is he who will condemn me? Behold, they will all grow old like a garment. The moths will eat them up. ¹⁰Who among you fears the LORD and obeys the voice of his servant? He who walks in darkness and has no light, let him trust in the LORD’s name, and rely on his God. ¹¹Behold, all you who kindle a fire, who adorn yourselves with torches around yourselves, walk in the flame of your fire, and among the torches that you have kindled. You will have this from my hand: you will lie down in sorrow.

51“Listen to me, you who follow after righteousness, you who seek the LORD. Look to the rock you were cut from, and to the quarry you were dug from. ²Look to Abraham your father, and to Sarah who bore you; for when he was but one I called him, I blessed him, and made him many. ³For the LORD has comforted Zion. He has comforted all her waste places, and has made her wilderness like Eden, and her desert like the garden of the LORD. Joy and gladness will be found in them, thanksgiving, and the voice of melody. ⁴“Listen to me, my people; and hear me, my nation, for a law will go out from me, and I will establish my justice for a light to the peoples. ⁵My righteousness is near. My salvation has gone out, and my arms will judge the peoples. The islands will wait for me, and they will trust my arm. ⁶Lift up your eyes to the heavens, and look at the earth beneath; for the heavens will vanish

away like smoke, and the earth will wear out like a garment. Its inhabitants will die in the same way, but my salvation will be forever, and my righteousness will not be abolished. ⁷“Listen to me, you who know righteousness, the people in whose heart is my law. Don’t fear the reproach of men, and don’t be dismayed at their insults. ⁸For the moth will eat them up like a garment, and the worm will eat them like wool; but my righteousness will be forever, and my salvation to all generations.” ⁹Awake, awake, put on strength, arm of the LORD! Awake, as in the days of old, the generations of ancient times. Isn’t it you who cut Rahab in pieces, who pierced the monster? ¹⁰Isn’t it you who dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep; who made the depths of the sea a way for the redeemed to pass over? ¹¹Those ransomed by the LORD will return, and come with singing to Zion. Everlasting joy shall be on their heads. They will obtain gladness and joy. Sorrow and sighing shall flee away. ¹²“I, even I, am he who comforts you. Who are you, that you are afraid of man who shall die, and of the son of man who will be made as grass? ¹³Have you forgotten the LORD your Maker, who stretched out the heavens, and laid the foundations of the earth? Do you live in fear continually all day because of the fury of the oppressor, when he prepares to destroy? Where is the fury of the oppressor? ¹⁴The captive exile will speedily be freed. He will not die and go down into the pit. His bread won’t fail. ¹⁵For I am the LORD your God, who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar. the LORD of Hosts is his name. ¹⁶I have put my words in your mouth and have covered you in the shadow of my hand, that I may plant the heavens, and lay the foundations of the earth, and tell Zion, ‘You are my people.’” ¹⁷Awake, awake! Stand up, Jerusalem, you who have drunk from the LORD’s hand the cup of his wrath. You have drunken the bowl of the cup of staggering, and drained it. ¹⁸There is no one to guide her among all the sons to whom she has given birth; and there is no one who takes her by the hand among all the sons whom she has brought up. ¹⁹These two things have happened to you— who will grieve with you?— desolation and destruction, and famine and the sword. How can I comfort you? ²⁰Your sons have fainted. They lie at the head of all the streets, like an antelope in a net. They are full of the LORD’s wrath, the rebuke of your God. ²¹Therefore now hear this, you afflicted, and drunken, but not with wine: ²²Your Lord GOD, your God who pleads the cause of his people, says, “Behold, I have taken out of your hand the cup of staggering, even the bowl of the cup of my wrath. You will not drink it any more. ²³I will put it into the hand of those who afflict you, who have said to your soul, ‘Bow down, that we may walk over you;’ and you have laid your back as the ground, like a street to those who walk over.”

52Awake, awake! Put on your strength, Zion. Put

on your beautiful garments, Jerusalem, the holy city, for from now on the uncircumcised and the unclean will no more come into you. ²Shake yourself from the dust! Arise, sit up, Jerusalem! Release yourself from the bonds of your neck, captive daughter of Zion! ³For the LORD says, “You were sold for nothing; and you will be redeemed without money.” ⁴For the Lord GOD says: “My people went down at the first into Egypt to live there; and the Assyrian has oppressed them without cause. ⁵“Now therefore, what do I do here,” says the LORD, “seeing that my people are taken away for nothing? Those who rule over them mock,” says the LORD, “and my name is blasphemed continually all day long. ⁶Therefore my people shall know my name. Therefore they shall know in that day that I am he who speaks. Behold, it is I.” ⁷How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of him who brings good news, who publishes peace, who brings good news, who proclaims salvation, who says to Zion, “Your God reigns!” ⁸Your watchmen lift up their voice. Together they sing; for they shall see eye to eye when the LORD returns to Zion. ⁹Break out into joy! Sing together, you waste places of Jerusalem; for the LORD has comforted his people. He has redeemed Jerusalem. ¹⁰The LORD has made his holy arm bare in the eyes of all the nations. All the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God. ¹¹Depart! Depart! Go out from there! Touch no unclean thing! Go out from among her! Cleanse yourselves, you who carry the LORD’s vessels. ¹²For you shall not go out in haste, neither shall you go by flight; for the LORD will go before you, and the God of Israel will be your rear guard. ¹³Behold, my servant will deal wisely. He will be exalted and lifted up, and will be very high. ¹⁴Just as many were astonished at you— his appearance was marred more than any man, and his form more than the sons of men— ¹⁵so he will cleanse ^{xxvi} many nations. Kings will shut their mouths at him; for they will see that which had not been told them, and they will understand that which they had not heard.

53Who has believed our message? To whom has the LORD’s arm been revealed? ²For he grew up before him as a tender plant, and as a root out of dry ground. He has no good looks or majesty. When we see him, there is no beauty that we should desire him. ³He was despised and rejected by men, a man of suffering and acquainted with disease. He was despised as one from whom men hide their face; and we didn’t respect him. ⁴Surely he has borne our sickness and carried our suffering; yet we considered him plagued, struck by God, and afflicted. ⁵But he was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed. ⁶All we like sheep have gone astray. Everyone has turned to his own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all. ⁷He

^{xxvi}or, sprinkle

was oppressed, yet when he was afflicted he didn't open his mouth. As a lamb that is led to the slaughter, and as a sheep that before its shearers is silent, so he didn't open his mouth. ⁸He was taken away by oppression and judgment. As for his generation, who considered that he was cut off out of the land of the living and stricken for the disobedience of my people? ⁹They made his grave with the wicked, and with a rich man in his death, although he had done no violence, nor was any deceit in his mouth. ¹⁰Yet it pleased the LORD to bruise him. He has caused him to suffer. When you make his soul an offering for sin, he will see his offspring. He will prolong his days and the LORD's pleasure will prosper in his hand. ¹¹After the suffering of his soul, he will see the light ^{xxvii} and be satisfied. My righteous servant will justify many by the knowledge of himself; and he will bear their iniquities. ¹²Therefore I will give him a portion with the great. He will divide the plunder with the strong, because he poured out his soul to death and was counted with the transgressors; yet he bore the sins of many and made intercession for the transgressors.

54“Sing, barren, you who didn't give birth! Break out into singing, and cry aloud, you who didn't travail with child! For more are the children of the desolate than the children of the married wife,” says the LORD. ²“Enlarge the place of your tent, and let them stretch out the curtains of your habitations; don't spare; lengthen your cords, and strengthen your stakes. ³For you will spread out on the right hand and on the left; and your offspring will possess the nations and settle in desolate cities. ⁴“Don't be afraid, for you will not be ashamed. Don't be confounded, for you will not be disappointed. For you will forget the shame of your youth. You will remember the reproach of your widowhood no more. ⁵For your Maker is your husband; the LORD of Hosts is his name. The Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer. He will be called the God of the whole earth. ⁶For the LORD has called you as a wife forsaken and grieved in spirit, even a wife of youth, when she is cast off,” says your God. ⁷“For a small moment I have forsaken you, but I will gather you with great mercies. ⁸In overflowing wrath I hid my face from you for a moment, but with everlasting loving kindness I will have mercy on you,” says the LORD your Redeemer. ⁹“For this is like the waters of Noah to me; for as I have sworn that the waters of Noah will no more go over the earth, so I have sworn that I will not be angry with you, nor rebuke you. ¹⁰For the mountains may depart, and the hills be removed, but my loving kindness will not depart from you, and my covenant of peace will not be removed,” says the LORD who has mercy on you. ¹¹“You afflicted, tossed with storms, and not comforted, behold, I will set your

stones in beautiful colors, and lay your foundations with sapphires. ¹²I will make your pinnacles of rubies, your gates of sparkling jewels, and all your walls of precious stones. ¹³All your children will be taught by the LORD, and your children's peace will be great. ¹⁴You will be established in righteousness. You will be far from oppression, for you will not be afraid, and far from terror, for it shall not come near you. ¹⁵Behold, they may gather together, but not by me. Whoever gathers together against you will fall because of you. ¹⁶“Behold, I have created the blacksmith who fans the coals into flame, and forges a weapon for his work; and I have created the destroyer to destroy. ¹⁷No weapon that is formed against you will prevail; and you will condemn every tongue that rises against you in judgment. This is the heritage of the LORD's servants, and their righteousness is of me,” says the LORD.

55“Hey! Come, everyone who thirsts, to the waters! Come, he who has no money, buy, and eat! Yes, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price. ²Why do you spend money for that which is not bread, and your labor for that which doesn't satisfy? Listen diligently to me, and eat that which is good, and let your soul delight itself in richness. ³Turn your ear, and come to me. Hear, and your soul will live. I will make an everlasting covenant with you, even the sure mercies of David. ⁴Behold, I have given him for a witness to the peoples, a leader and commander to the peoples. ⁵Behold, you shall call a nation that you don't know; and a nation that didn't know you shall run to you, because of the LORD your God, and for the Holy One of Israel; for he has glorified you.” ⁶Seek the LORD while he may be found. Call on him while he is near. ⁷Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts. Let him return to the LORD, and he will have mercy on him, to our God, for he will freely pardon. ⁸“For my thoughts are not your thoughts, and your ways are not my ways,” says the LORD. ⁹“For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways, and my thoughts than your thoughts. ¹⁰For as the rain comes down and the snow from the sky, and doesn't return there, but waters the earth, and makes it grow and bud, and gives seed to the sower and bread to the eater; ¹¹so is my word that goes out of my mouth: it will not return to me void, but it will accomplish that which I please, and it will prosper in the thing I sent it to do. ¹²For you shall go out with joy, and be led out with peace. The mountains and the hills will break out before you into singing; and all the trees of the fields will clap their hands. ¹³Instead of the thorn the cypress tree will come up; and instead of the brier the myrtle tree will come up. It will make a name for the LORD, for an everlasting sign that will not be cut off.”

^{xxvii}So read the Dead Sea Scrolls and Septuagint. Masoretic Text omits “the light”.

56The LORD says: “Maintain justice and do what is

right, for my salvation [yeshuah-ti] is near and my righteousness will soon be revealed. ²Blessed is the man who does this, and the son of man who holds it fast; who keeps the Sabbath without profaning it and keeps his hand from doing any evil.” ³Let no foreigner who has joined himself to the LORD speak, saying, “The LORD will surely separate me from his people.” Do not let the eunuch say, “Behold, I am a dry tree.” ⁴For the LORD says, “To the eunuchs who keep my Sabbaths, choose the things that please me, and hold fast to my covenant, ⁵I will give them in my house and within my walls a memorial and a name better than of sons and of daughters. I will give them an everlasting name that will not be cut off. ⁶Also the foreigners who join themselves to the LORD to serve him, and to love the LORD’s name, to be his servants, everyone who keeps the Sabbath from profaning it, and holds fast my covenant, ⁷I will bring these to my holy mountain, and make them joyful in my house of prayer. Their burnt offerings and their sacrifices will be accepted on my altar; for my house will be called a house of prayer for all peoples.” ⁸The Lord GOD, who gathers the outcasts of Israel, says, “I will yet gather others to him, in addition to his own who are gathered.” ⁹All you animals of the field, come to devour, all you animals in the forest. ¹⁰His watchmen are blind. They are all without knowledge. They are all mute dogs. They can’t bark—dreaming, lying down, loving to slumber. ¹¹Yes, the dogs are greedy. They can never have enough. They are shepherds who can’t understand. They have all turned to their own way, each one to his gain, from every quarter. ¹²“Come,” they say, “I will get wine, and we will fill ourselves with strong drink; and tomorrow will be as today, great beyond measure.”

57 The righteous perish, and no one lays it to heart. Merciful men are taken away, and no one considers that the righteous is taken away from the evil. ²He enters into peace. They rest in their beds, each one who walks in his uprightness. ³“But draw near here, you sons of a sorceress, you offspring of adulterers and prostitutes. ⁴Whom do you mock? Against whom do you make a wide mouth and stick out your tongue? Aren’t you children of disobedience and offspring of falsehood, ⁵you who inflame yourselves among the oaks, under every green tree; who kill the children in the valleys, under the clefts of the rocks? ⁶Among the smooth stones of the valley is your portion. They, they are your lot. You have even poured a drink offering to them. You have offered an offering. Shall I be appeased for these things? ⁷On a high and lofty mountain you have set your bed. You also went up there to offer sacrifice. ⁸You have set up your memorial behind the doors and the posts, for you have exposed yourself to someone besides me, and have gone up. You have enlarged your bed and made you a covenant with them. You loved what you saw on their bed. ⁹You went to the king with oil, increased your perfumes,

sent your ambassadors far off, and degraded yourself even to Sheol. ^{xxviii} ¹⁰You were wearied with the length of your ways; yet you didn’t say, ‘It is in vain.’ You found a reviving of your strength; therefore you weren’t faint. ¹¹“Whom have you dreaded and feared, so that you lie, and have not remembered me, nor laid it to your heart? Haven’t I held my peace for a long time, and you don’t fear me? ¹²I will declare your righteousness; and as for your works, they will not benefit you. ¹³When you cry, let those whom you have gathered deliver you, but the wind will take them. A breath will carry them all away, but he who takes refuge in me will possess the land, and will inherit my holy mountain.” ¹⁴He will say, “Build up, build up, prepare the way! Remove the stumbling-block out of the way of my people.” ¹⁵For the high and lofty One who inhabits eternity, whose name is Holy, says: “I dwell in the high and holy place, with him also who is of a contrite and humble spirit, to revive the spirit of the humble, and to revive the heart of the contrite. ¹⁶For I will not contend forever, neither will I always be angry; for the spirit would faint before me, and the souls whom I have made. ¹⁷I was angry because of the iniquity of his covetousness and struck him. I hid myself and was angry; and he went on backsliding in the way of his heart. ¹⁸I have seen his ways, and will heal him. I will lead him also, and restore comforts to him and to his mourners. ¹⁹I create the fruit of the lips: Peace, peace, to him who is far off and to him who is near,” says the LORD; “and I will heal them.” ²⁰But the wicked are like the troubled sea; for it can’t rest and its waters cast up mire and mud. ²¹“There is no peace”, says my God, “for the wicked.”

58 “Cry aloud! Don’t spare! Lift up your voice like a shofar! Declare to my people their disobedience, and to the house of Jacob their sins. ²Yet they seek me daily, and delight to know my ways. As a nation that did righteousness, and didn’t forsake the ordinance of their God, they ask of me righteous judgments. They delight to draw near to God. ³‘Why have we fasted,’ they say, ‘and you don’t see? Why have we afflicted our soul, and you don’t notice?’ “Behold, in the day of your fast you find pleasure, and oppress all your laborers. ⁴Behold, you fast for strife and contention, and to strike with the fist of wickedness. You don’t fast today so as to make your voice to be heard on high. ⁵Is this the fast that I have chosen? A day for a man to humble his soul? Is it to bow down his head like a reed, and to spread sackcloth and ashes under himself? Will you call this a fast, and an acceptable day to the LORD? ⁶“Isn’t this the fast that I have chosen: to release the bonds of wickedness, to undo the straps of the yoke, to let the oppressed go free, and that you break every yoke? ⁷Isn’t it to distribute your bread to the hungry, and that you bring the poor who are cast out

^{xxviii} Sheol is the place of the dead.

to your house? When you see the naked, that you cover him; and that you not hide yourself from your own flesh? ⁸Then your light will break out as the morning, and your healing will appear quickly; then your righteousness shall go before you, and the LORD's glory will be your rear guard. ⁹Then you will call, and the LORD will answer. You will cry for help, and he will say, 'Here I am.' "If you take away from among you the yoke, finger pointing, and speaking wickedly; ¹⁰and if you pour out your soul to the hungry, and satisfy the afflicted soul, then your light will rise in darkness, and your obscurity will be as the noonday; ¹¹and the LORD will guide you continually, satisfy your soul in dry places, and make your bones strong. You will be like a watered garden, and like a spring of water whose waters don't fail. ¹²Those who will be of you will build the old waste places. You will raise up the foundations of many generations. You will be called Repairer of the Breach, Restorer of Paths with Dwellings. ¹³"If you turn away your foot from the Sabbath, from doing your pleasure on my holy day, and call the Sabbath a delight, and the holy of the LORD honorable, and honor it, not doing your own ways, nor finding your own pleasure, nor speaking your own words, ¹⁴then you will delight yourself in the LORD, and I will make you to ride on the high places of the earth, and I will feed you with the heritage of Jacob your father;" for the LORD's mouth has spoken it.

59Behold, the LORD's hand is not shortened, that it can't save; nor his ear dull, that it can't hear. ²But your iniquities have separated you and your God, and your sins have hidden his face from you, so that he will not hear. ³For your hands are defiled with blood, and your fingers with iniquity. Your lips have spoken lies. Your tongue mutters wickedness. ⁴No one sues in righteousness, and no one pleads in truth. They trust in vanity and speak lies. They conceive mischief and give birth to iniquity. ⁵They hatch adders' eggs and weave the spider's web. He who eats of their eggs dies; and that which is crushed breaks out into a viper. ⁶Their webs won't become garments. They won't cover themselves with their works. Their works are works of iniquity, and acts of violence are in their hands. ⁷Their feet run to evil, and they hurry to shed innocent blood. Their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity. Desolation and destruction are in their paths. ⁸They don't know the way of peace; and there is no justice in their ways. They have made crooked paths for themselves; whoever goes in them doesn't know peace. ⁹Therefore justice is far from us, and righteousness doesn't overtake us. We look for light, but see darkness; for brightness, but we walk in obscurity. ¹⁰We grope for the wall like the blind. Yes, we grope as those who have no eyes. We stumble at noon as if it were twilight. Among those who are strong, we are like dead men. ¹¹We all roar like bears and moan sadly like doves. We look for justice, but there is none, for salvation, but

it is far off from us. ¹²For our transgressions are multiplied before you, and our sins testify against us; for our transgressions are with us, and as for our iniquities, we know them: ¹³transgressing and denying the LORD, and turning away from following our God, speaking oppression and revolt, conceiving and uttering from the heart words of falsehood. ¹⁴Justice is turned away backward, and righteousness stands far away; for truth has fallen in the street, and uprightness can't enter. ¹⁵Yes, truth is lacking; and he who departs from evil makes himself a prey. The LORD saw it, and it displeased him that there was no justice. ¹⁶He saw that there was no man, and wondered that there was no intercessor. Therefore his own arm brought salvation to him; and his righteousness sustained him. ¹⁷He put on righteousness as a breastplate, and a helmet of salvation on his head. He put on garments of vengeance for clothing, and was clad with zeal as a mantle. ¹⁸According to their deeds, he will repay as appropriate: wrath to his adversaries, recompense to his enemies. He will repay the islands their due. ¹⁹So they will fear the LORD's name from the west, and his glory from the rising of the sun; for he will come as a rushing stream, which the LORD's breath drives. ²⁰"A Redeemer will come to Zion, and to those who turn from disobedience in Jacob," says the LORD. ²¹"As for me, this is my covenant with them," says the LORD. "My Spirit who is on you, and my words which I have put in your mouth shall not depart out of your mouth, nor out of the mouth of your offspring, nor out of the mouth of your offspring's offspring," says the LORD, "from now on and forever."

60"Arise, shine; for your light has come, and the LORD's glory has risen on you! ²For behold, darkness will cover the earth, and thick darkness the peoples; but the LORD will arise on you, and his glory shall be seen on you. ³Nations will come to your light, and kings to the brightness of your rising. ⁴"Lift up your eyes all around, and see: they all gather themselves together. They come to you. Your sons will come from far away, and your daughters will be carried in arms. ⁵Then you shall see and be radiant, and your heart will thrill and be enlarged; because the abundance of the sea will be turned to you. The wealth of the nations will come to you. ⁶A multitude of camels will cover you, the dromedaries of Midian and Efah. All from Sheba will come. They will bring gold and frankincense, and will proclaim the praises of the LORD. ⁷All the flocks of Kedar will be gathered together to you. The rams of Nebaioth will serve you. They will be accepted as offerings on my altar; and I will beautify my glorious house. ⁸"Who are these who fly as a cloud, and as the doves to their windows? ⁹Surely the islands will wait for me, and the ships of Tarshish first, to bring your sons from far away, their silver and their gold with them, for the name of the LORD your God, and for the Holy One of Israel, because he has

glorified you. ¹⁰“Foreigners will build up your walls, and their kings will serve you; for in my wrath I struck you, but in my favor I have had mercy on you. ¹¹Your gates also shall be open continually; they shall not be shut day nor night, that men may bring to you the wealth of the nations, and their kings led captive. ¹²For that nation and kingdom that will not serve you shall perish; yes, those nations shall be utterly wasted. ¹³“The glory of Lebanon shall come to you, the cypress tree, the pine, and the box tree together, to beautify the place of my sanctuary; and I will make the place of my feet glorious. ¹⁴The sons of those who afflicted you will come bowing to you; and all those who despised you will bow themselves down at the soles of your feet. They will call you the LORD’s City, the Zion of the Holy One of Israel. ¹⁵“Whereas you have been forsaken and hated, so that no one passed through you, I will make you an eternal excellency, a joy of many generations. ¹⁶You will also drink the milk of the nations, and will nurse from royal breasts. Then you will know that I, the LORD, am your Savior, your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob. ¹⁷For bronze I will bring gold; for iron I will bring silver; for wood, bronze, and for stones, iron. I will also make peace your governor, and righteousness your ruler. ¹⁸Violence shall no more be heard in your land, nor desolation or destruction within your borders; but you will call your walls Salvation, and your gates Praise. ¹⁹The sun will be no more your light by day, nor will the brightness of the moon give light to you, but the LORD will be your everlasting light, and your God will be your glory. ²⁰Your sun will not go down any more, nor will your moon withdraw itself; for the LORD will be your everlasting light, and the days of your mourning will end. ²¹Then your people will all be righteous. They will inherit the land forever, the branch of my planting, the work of my hands, that I may be glorified. ²²The little one will become a thousand, and the small one a strong nation. I, the LORD, will do this quickly in its time.”

61 The Lord GOD’s Spirit is on me, because the LORD has anointed me to proclaim good news to the humble. He has sent me to bind up the broken hearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and release to those who are bound, ^{xxix} ²to proclaim the year of the LORD’s favor and the day of vengeance of our God, to comfort all who mourn, ³to provide for those who mourn in Zion, to give to them a garland for ashes, the oil of joy for mourning, the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness, that they may be called trees of righteousness, the planting of the LORD, that he may be glorified. ⁴They will rebuild the old ruins. They will raise up the former devastated places. They will repair the ruined cities that have been devastated for many generations. ⁵Strangers will stand and feed your flocks. Foreigners will work your fields and your vineyards. ⁶But

you will be called the LORD’s priests. Men will call you the servants of our God. You will eat the wealth of the nations. You will boast in their glory. ⁷Instead of your shame you will have double. Instead of dishonor, they will rejoice in their portion. Therefore in their land they will possess double. Everlasting joy will be to them. ⁸“For I, the LORD, love justice. I hate robbery and iniquity. I will give them their reward in truth and I will make an everlasting covenant with them. ⁹Their offspring will be known among the nations, and their offspring among the peoples. All who see them will acknowledge them, that they are the offspring which the LORD has blessed.” ¹⁰I will greatly rejoice in the LORD! My soul will be joyful in my God, for he has clothed me with the garments of salvation. He has covered me with the robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom decks himself with a garland and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels. ¹¹For as the earth produces its bud, and as the garden causes the things that are sown in it to spring up, so the Lord GOD will cause righteousness and praise to spring up before all the nations.

62 For Zion’s sake I will not hold my peace, and for Jerusalem’s sake I will not rest, until her righteousness shines out like the dawn, and her salvation like a burning lamp. ²The nations will see your righteousness, and all kings your glory. You will be called by a new name, which the LORD’s mouth will name. ³You will also be a crown of beauty in the LORD’s hand, and a royal diadem in your God’s hand. ⁴You will not be called Forsaken any more, nor will your land be called Desolate any more; but you will be called Hephzibah, ^{xxx} and your land Beulah; ^{xxxi} for the LORD delights in you, and your land will be married. ⁵For as a young man marries a virgin, so your sons will marry you. As a bridegroom rejoices over his bride, so your God will rejoice over you. ⁶I have set watchmen on your walls, Jerusalem. They will never be silent day nor night. You who call on the LORD, take no rest, ⁷and give him no rest until he establishes, and until he makes Jerusalem a praise in the earth. ⁸The LORD has sworn by his right hand, and by the arm of his strength, “Surely I will no more give your grain to be food for your enemies, and foreigners will not drink your new wine, for which you have labored, ⁹but those who have harvested it will eat it, and praise the LORD. Those who have gathered it will drink it in the courts of my sanctuary.” ¹⁰Go through, go through the gates! Prepare the way of the people! Build up, build up the highway! Gather out the stones! Lift up a banner for the peoples. ¹¹Behold, the LORD has proclaimed to the end of the earth: “Say to the daughter of Zion, ‘Behold, your salvation comes! Behold, his reward is with him, and his recompense before him!’” ¹²They will call them “The

^{xxx}Hephzibah means “I delight in her”.

^{xxxi}Beulah means “married”

^{xxix}LXX and DSS add: recovery of sight to the blind

Holy People, The LORD's Redeemed". You will be called name.
 "Sought Out, A City Not Forsaken".

63Who is this who comes from Edom, with dyed garments from Bozrah? Who is this who is glorious in his clothing, marching in the greatness of his strength? "It is I who speak in righteousness, mighty to save." ²Why is your clothing red, and your garments like him who treads in the wine vat? ³"I have trodden the wine press alone. Of the peoples, no one was with me. Yes, I trod them in my anger and trampled them in my wrath. Their lifeblood is sprinkled on my garments, and I have stained all my clothing. ⁴For the day of vengeance was in my heart, and the year of my redeemed has come. ⁵I looked, and there was no one to help; and I wondered that there was no one to uphold. Therefore my own arm brought salvation to me. My own wrath upheld me. ⁶I trod down the peoples in my anger and made them drunk in my wrath. I poured their lifeblood out on the earth." ⁷I will tell of the loving kindnesses of the LORD and the praises of the LORD, according to all that the LORD has given to us, and the great goodness toward the house of Israel, which he has given to them according to his mercies, and according to the multitude of his loving kindnesses. ⁸For he said, "Surely, they are my people, children who will not deal falsely;" so he became their Savior. ⁹In all their affliction he was afflicted, and the angel of his presence saved them. In his love and in his pity he redeemed them. He bore them, and carried them all the days of old. ¹⁰But they rebelled and grieved his Holy Spirit. Therefore he turned and became their enemy, and he himself fought against them. ¹¹Then he remembered the days of old, Moses and his people, saying, "Where is he who brought them up out of the sea with the shepherds of his flock? Where is he who put his Holy Spirit among them?" ¹²Who caused his glorious arm to be at Moses' right hand? Who divided the waters before them, to make himself an everlasting name? ¹³Who led them through the depths, like a horse in the wilderness, so that they didn't stumble? ¹⁴As the livestock that go down into the valley, the LORD's Spirit caused them to rest. So you led your people to make yourself a glorious name. ¹⁵Look down from heaven, and see from the habitation of your holiness and of your glory. Where are your zeal and your mighty acts? The yearning of your heart and your compassion is restrained toward me. ¹⁶For you are our Father, though Abraham doesn't know us, and Israel does not acknowledge us. You, LORD, are our Father. Our Redeemer from everlasting is your name. ¹⁷O LORD, why do you make us wander from your ways, and harden our heart from your fear? Return for your servants' sake, the tribes of your inheritance. ¹⁸Your holy people possessed it but a little while. Our adversaries have trodden down your sanctuary. ¹⁹We have become like those over whom you never ruled, like those who were not called by your

64Oh that you would tear the heavens, that you would come down, that the mountains might quake at your presence—
²as when fire kindles the brushwood, and the fire causes the water to boil. Make your name known to your adversaries, that the nations may tremble at your presence!
³When you did awesome things which we didn't look for, you came down, and the mountains quaked at your presence. ⁴For from of old men have not heard, nor perceived by the ear, nor has the eye seen a God besides you, who works for him who waits for him. ⁵You meet him who rejoices and does righteousness, those who remember you in your ways. Behold, you were angry, and we sinned. We have been in sin for a long time. Shall we be saved? ⁶For we have all become like one who is unclean, and all our righteousness is like a polluted garment. We all fade like a leaf; and our iniquities, like the wind, take us away. ⁷There is no one who calls on your name, who stirs himself up to take hold of you; for you have hidden your face from us, and have consumed us by means of our iniquities. ⁸But now, LORD, you are our Father. We are the clay and you our potter. We all are the work of your hand. ⁹Don't be furious, LORD. Don't remember iniquity forever. Look and see, we beg you, we are all your people. ¹⁰Your holy cities have become a wilderness. Zion has become a wilderness, Jerusalem a desolation. ¹¹Our holy and our beautiful house where our fathers praised you is burned with fire. All our pleasant places are laid waste. ¹²Will you hold yourself back for these things, LORD? Will you keep silent and punish us very severely?

65"I am inquired of by those who didn't ask. I am found by those who didn't seek me. I said, 'See me, see me,' to a nation that was not called by my name. ²I have spread out my hands all day to a rebellious people, who walk in a way that is not good, after their own thoughts; ³a people who provoke me to my face continually, sacrificing in gardens, and burning incense on bricks; ⁴who sit among the graves, and spend nights in secret places; who eat pig's meat, and broth of abominable things is in their vessels; ⁵who say, 'Stay by yourself, don't come near to me, for I am holier than you.' These are smoke in my nose, a fire that burns all day. ⁶"Behold, it is written before me: I will not keep silence, but will repay, yes, I will repay into their bosom ⁷your own iniquities and the iniquities of your fathers together", says the LORD, "who have burned incense on the mountains, and blasphemed me on the hills. Therefore I will first measure their work into their bosom." ⁸The LORD says, "As the new wine is found in the cluster, and one says, 'Don't destroy it, for a blessing is in it:' so I will do for my servants' sake, that I may not destroy them all. ⁹I will bring offspring out of Jacob, and out of Judah an inheritor of my mountains. My chosen will

inherit it, and my servants will dwell there. ¹⁰Sharon will be a fold of flocks, and the valley of Achor a place for herds to lie down in, for my people who have sought me. ¹¹“But you who forsake the LORD, who forget my holy mountain, who prepare a table for Fortune, and who fill up mixed wine to Destiny; ¹²I will destine you to the sword, and you will all bow down to the slaughter; because when I called, you didn’t answer. When I spoke, you didn’t listen; but you did that which was evil in my eyes, and chose that in which I didn’t delight.” ¹³Therefore the Lord GOD says, “Behold, my servants will eat, but you will be hungry; behold, my servants will drink, but you will be thirsty. Behold, my servants will rejoice, but you will be disappointed. ¹⁴Behold, my servants will sing for joy of heart, but you will cry for sorrow of heart, and will wail for anguish of spirit. ¹⁵You will leave your name for a curse to my chosen, and the Lord GOD will kill you. He will call his servants by another name, ¹⁶so that he who blesses himself in the earth will bless himself in the God of truth; and he who swears in the earth will swear by the God of truth; because the former troubles are forgotten, and because they are hidden from my eyes. ¹⁷“For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth; and the former things will not be remembered, nor come into mind. ¹⁸But be glad and rejoice forever in that which I create; for, behold, I create Jerusalem to be a delight, and her people a joy. ¹⁹I will rejoice in Jerusalem, and delight in my people; and the voice of weeping and the voice of crying will be heard in her no more. ²⁰“No more will there be an infant who only lives a few days, nor an old man who has not filled his days; for the child will die one hundred years old, and the sinner being one hundred years old will be accursed. ²¹They will build houses and inhabit them. They will plant vineyards and eat their fruit. ²²They will not build and another inhabit. They will not plant and another eat; for the days of my people will be like the days of a tree, and my chosen will long enjoy the work of their hands. ²³They will not labor in vain nor give birth for calamity; for they are the offspring of the LORD’s blessed and their descendants with them. ²⁴It will happen that before they call, I will answer; and while they are yet speaking, I will hear. ²⁵The wolf and the lamb will feed together. The lion will eat straw like the ox. Dust will be the serpent’s food. They will not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain,” says the LORD.

66The LORD says: “Heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool. What kind of house will you build to me? Where will I rest? ²For my hand has made all these things, and so all these things came to be,” says the LORD: “but I will look to this man, even to he who is poor and of a contrite spirit, and who trembles at my word. ³He who kills an ox is as he who kills a man; he who sacrifices a lamb, as he who breaks a dog’s neck; he

who offers an offering, as he who offers pig’s blood; he who burns frankincense, as he who blesses an idol. Yes, they have chosen their own ways, and their soul delights in their abominations. ⁴I also will choose their delusions, and will bring their fears on them, because when I called, no one answered; when I spoke, they didn’t listen, but they did that which was evil in my eyes, and chose that in which I didn’t delight.” ⁵Hear the LORD’s word, you who tremble at his word: “Your brothers who hate you, who cast you out for my name’s sake, have said, ‘Let the LORD be glorified, that we may see your joy;’ but it is those who shall be disappointed. ⁶A voice of tumult from the city, a voice from the temple, a voice of the LORD that repays his enemies what they deserve. ⁷“Before she travailed, she gave birth. Before her pain came, she delivered a son. ⁸Who has heard of such a thing? Who has seen such things? Shall a land be born in one day? Shall a nation be born at once? For as soon as Zion travailed, she gave birth to her children. ⁹Shall I bring to the birth, and not cause to be delivered?” says the LORD. “Shall I who cause to give birth shut the womb?” says your God. ¹⁰“Rejoice with Jerusalem, and be glad for her, all you who love her. Rejoice for joy with her, all you who mourn over her; ¹¹that you may nurse and be satisfied at the comforting breasts; that you may drink deeply, and be delighted with the abundance of her glory.” ¹²For the LORD says, “Behold, I will extend peace to her like a river, and the glory of the nations like an overflowing stream, and you will nurse. You will be carried on her side, and will be dandled on her knees. ¹³As one whom his mother comforts, so I will comfort you. You will be comforted in Jerusalem.” ¹⁴You will see it, and your heart shall rejoice, and your bones will flourish like the tender grass. The LORD’s hand will be known among his servants; and he will have indignation against his enemies. ¹⁵For, behold, the LORD will come with fire, and his chariots will be like the whirlwind; to render his anger with fierceness, and his rebuke with flames of fire. ¹⁶For the LORD will execute judgment by fire and by his sword on all flesh; and those slain by the LORD will be many. ¹⁷“Those who sanctify themselves and purify themselves to go to the gardens, following one in the middle, eating pig’s meat, abominable things, and the mouse, they shall come to an end together,” says the LORD. ¹⁸“For I know their works and their thoughts. The time comes that I will gather all nations and languages, and they will come, and will see my glory. ¹⁹“I will set a sign among them, and I will send those who escape of them to the nations, to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, who draw the bow, to Tubal and Javan, to far-away islands, who have not heard my fame, nor have seen my glory; and they shall declare my glory among the nations. ²⁰They shall bring all your brothers out of all the nations for an offering to the LORD, on horses, in chariots, in litters, on mules, and on camels, to my holy mountain Jerusalem, says the LORD, as the chil-

dren of Israel bring their offering in a clean vessel into the LORD's house. ²¹Of them I will also select priests and Levites," says the LORD. ²²"For as the new heavens and the new earth, which I will make, shall remain before me," says the LORD, "so your offspring and your name shall remain. ²³It shall happen that from one new moon to another, and from one Sabbath to another, all flesh will come to worship before me," says the LORD. ²⁴"They will go out, and look at the dead bodies of the men who have transgressed against me; for their worm will not die, nor will their fire be quenched, and they will be loathsome to all mankind."

Jeremiah

¹The words of Jeremiah the son of Hilkiah, one of the priests who were in Anathoth in the land of Benjamin. ²The LORD's ⁱ word came to him in the days of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah, in the thirteenth year of his reign. ³It came also in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, to the end of the eleventh year of Zedekiah, the son of Josiah, king of Judah, to the carrying away of Jerusalem captive in the fifth month. ⁴Now the LORD's word came to me, saying, ⁵"Before I formed you in the womb, I knew you. Before you were born, I sanctified you. I have appointed you a prophet to the nations." ⁶Then I said, "Ah, Lord ⁱⁱ GOD! Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I don't know how to speak; for I am a child." ⁷But the LORD said to me, "Don't say, 'I am a child;' for you must go to whomever I send you, and you must say whatever I command you. ⁸Don't be afraid because of them, for I am with you to rescue you," says the LORD. ⁹Then the LORD stretched out his hand and touched my mouth. Then the LORD said to me, "Behold, I have put my words in your mouth. ¹⁰Behold, I have today set you over the nations and over the kingdoms, to uproot and to tear down, to destroy and to overthrow, to build and to plant." ¹¹Moreover the LORD's word came to me, saying, "Jeremiah, what do you see?" I said, "I see a branch of an almond tree." ¹²Then the LORD said to me, "You have seen well; for I watch over my word to perform it." ¹³The LORD's word came to me the second time, saying, "What do you see?" I said, "I see a boiling cauldron; and it is tipping away from the north." ¹⁴Then the LORD said to me, "Out of the north, evil will break out on all the inhabitants of the land. ¹⁵For behold, I will call all the families of the kingdoms of the north," says the LORD. "They will come, and they will each set his throne at the entrance of the gates of Jerusalem, and against all its walls all around, and against all the cities of Judah. ¹⁶I will utter my judgments against them concerning all their wickedness, in that they have forsaken me, and have burned incense to other gods, and worshiped the works of their own hands. ¹⁷"You therefore

put your belt on your waist, arise, and say to them all that I command you. Don't be dismayed at them, lest I dismay you before them. ¹⁸For behold, I have made you today a fortified city, an iron pillar, and bronze walls against the whole land—against the kings of Judah, against its princes, against its priests, and against the people of the land. ¹⁹They will fight against you, but they will not prevail against you; for I am with you", says the LORD, "to rescue you."

²The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Go and proclaim in the ears of Jerusalem, saying, 'The LORD says, "I remember for you the kindness of your youth, your love as a bride, how you went after me in the wilderness, in a land that was not sown. ³Israel was holiness to the LORD, the first fruits of his increase. All who devour him will be held guilty. Evil will come on them,"' says the LORD." ⁴Hear the LORD's word, O house of Jacob, and all the families of the house of Israel! ⁵The LORD says, "What unrighteousness have your fathers found in me, that they have gone far from me, and have walked after worthless vanity, and have become worthless? ⁶They didn't say, 'Where is the LORD who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, who led us through the wilderness, through a land of deserts and of pits, through a land of drought and of the shadow of death, through a land that no one passed through, and where no man lived?' ⁷I brought you into a plentiful land to eat its fruit and its goodness; but when you entered, you defiled my land, and made my heritage an abomination. ⁸The priests didn't say, 'Where is the LORD?' and those who handle the law didn't know me. The rulers also transgressed against me, and the prophets prophesied by Baal and followed things that do not profit. ⁹"Therefore I will yet contend with you," says the LORD, "and I will contend with your children's children. ¹⁰For pass over to the islands of Kittim, and see. Send to Kedar, and consider diligently, and see if there has been such a thing. ¹¹Has a nation changed its gods, which really are no gods? But my people have changed their glory for that which doesn't profit. ¹²"Be astonished, you heavens, at this and be horribly afraid. Be very desolate," says the LORD. ¹³"For my people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the spring of living waters, and cut out cisterns for

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

themselves: broken cisterns that can't hold water. ¹⁴Is Israel a slave? Is he born into slavery? Why has he become a captive? ¹⁵The young lions have roared at him and raised their voices. They have made his land waste. His cities are burned up, without inhabitant. ¹⁶The children also of Memphis and Tahpanhes have broken the crown of your head. ¹⁷"Haven't you brought this on yourself, in that you have forsaken the LORD your God, ^{iv} when he led you by the way? ¹⁸Now what do you gain by going to Egypt, to drink the waters of the Shihor? Or why do you to go on the way to Assyria, to drink the waters of the River? ^v ¹⁹"Your own wickedness will correct you, and your backsliding will rebuke you. Know therefore and see that it is an evil and bitter thing, that you have forsaken the LORD your God, and that my fear is not in you," says the Lord, the LORD of Hosts. ²⁰"For long ago I broke off your yoke, and burst your bonds. You said, 'I will not serve;' for on every high hill and under every green tree you bowed yourself, playing the prostitute. ²¹Yet I had planted you a noble vine, a pure and faithful seed. How then have you turned into the degenerate branches of a foreign vine to me? ²²For though you wash yourself with lye, and use much soap, yet your iniquity is marked before me," says the Lord GOD. ²³"How can you say, 'I am not defiled. I have not gone after the Baals'? See your way in the valley. Know what you have done. You are a swift dromedary traversing her ways, ²⁴a wild donkey used to the wilderness, that sniffs the wind in her craving. When she is in heat, who can turn her away? All those who seek her will not weary themselves. In her month, they will find her. ²⁵"Keep your feet from being bare, and your throat from thirst. But you said, 'It is in vain. No, for I have loved strangers, and I will go after them.' ²⁶As the thief is ashamed when he is found, so the house of Israel is ashamed—they, their kings, their princes, their priests, and their prophets, ²⁷who tell wood, 'You are my father,' and a stone, 'You have given birth to me,' for they have turned their back to me, and not their face, but in the time of their trouble they will say, 'Arise, and save us!' ²⁸"But where are your gods that you have made for yourselves? Let them arise, if they can save you in the time of your trouble, for you have as many gods as you have towns, O Judah. ²⁹"Why will you contend with me? You all have transgressed against me," says the LORD. ³⁰"I have struck your children in vain. They received no correction. Your own sword has devoured your prophets, like a destroying lion. ³¹Generation, consider the LORD's word. Have I been a wilderness to Israel? Or a land of thick darkness? Why do my people say, 'We have broken loose. We will come to you no more'? ³²"Can a virgin forget her ornaments, or a bride her attire? Yet my people have forgotten me for days without number. ³³How well you

prepare your way to seek love! Therefore you have even taught the wicked women your ways. ³⁴Also the blood of the souls of the innocent poor is found in your skirts. You didn't find them breaking in, but it is because of all these things. ³⁵"Yet you said, 'I am innocent. Surely his anger has turned away from me.' "Behold, I will judge you, because you say, 'I have not sinned.' ³⁶Why do you go about so much to change your ways? You will be ashamed of Egypt also, as you were ashamed of Assyria. ³⁷You will also leave that place with your hands on your head; for the LORD has rejected those in whom you trust, and you won't prosper with them.

3"They say, 'If a man puts away his wife, and she goes from him, and becomes another man's, should he return to her again?' Wouldn't that land be greatly polluted? But you have played the prostitute with many lovers; yet return again to me," says the LORD. ²"Lift up your eyes to the bare heights, and see! Where have you not been lain with? You have sat waiting for them by the road, as an Arabian in the wilderness. You have polluted the land with your prostitution and with your wickedness. ³Therefore the showers have been withheld and there has been no latter rain; yet you have had a prostitute's forehead and you refused to be ashamed. ⁴Will you not from this time cry to me, 'My Father, you are the guide of my youth!'" ⁵"Will he retain his anger forever? Will he keep it to the end?' Behold, you have spoken and have done evil things, and have had your way." ⁶Moreover, the LORD said to me in the days of Josiah the king, "Have you seen that which backsliding Israel has done? She has gone up on every high mountain and under every green tree, and has played the prostitute there. ⁷I said after she had done all these things, 'She will return to me;' but she didn't return, and her treacherous sister Judah saw it. ⁸I saw when, for this very cause, that backsliding Israel had committed adultery, I had put her away and given her a certificate of divorce, yet treacherous Judah, her sister, had no fear, but she also went and played the prostitute. ⁹Because she took her prostitution lightly, the land was polluted, and she committed adultery with stones and with wood. ¹⁰Yet for all this her treacherous sister, Judah, has not returned to me with her whole heart, but only in pretense," says the LORD. ¹¹The LORD said to me, "Backsliding Israel has shown herself more righteous than treacherous Judah. ¹²Go, and proclaim these words toward the north, and say, 'Return, you backsliding Israel,' says the LORD; 'I will not look in anger on you, for I am merciful,' says the LORD. 'I will not keep anger forever. ¹³Only acknowledge your iniquity, that you have transgressed against the LORD your God, and have scattered your ways to the strangers under every green tree, and you have not obeyed my voice,'" says the LORD. ¹⁴"Return, backsliding children," says the LORD, "for I am a husband to you. I will take one of you

^{iv}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^vi.e., the Euphrates River

from a city, and two from a family, and I will bring you to Zion. ¹⁵I will give you shepherds according to my heart, who will feed you with knowledge and understanding. ¹⁶It will come to pass, when you are multiplied and increased in the land in those days," says the LORD, "they will no longer say, 'the ark of the LORD's covenant!' It will not come to mind. They won't remember it. They won't miss it, nor will another be made. ¹⁷At that time they will call Jerusalem 'The LORD's Throne;' and all the nations will be gathered to it, to the LORD's name, to Jerusalem. They will no longer walk after the stubbornness of their evil heart. ¹⁸In those days the house of Judah will walk with the house of Israel, and they will come together out of the land of the north to the land that I gave for an inheritance to your fathers. ¹⁹"But I said, 'How I desire to put you among the children, and give you a pleasant land, a goodly heritage of the armies of the nations!' and I said, 'You shall call me "My Father", and shall not turn away from following me.' ²⁰"Surely as a wife treacherously departs from her husband, so you have dealt treacherously with me, house of Israel," says the LORD. ²¹A voice is heard on the bare heights, the weeping and the petitions of the children of Israel; because they have perverted their way, they have forgotten the LORD their God. ²²Return, you backsliding children, and I will heal your backsliding. "Behold, we have come to you; for you are the LORD our God. ²³Truly help from the hills, the tumult on the mountains, is in vain. Truly the salvation of Israel is in the LORD our God. ²⁴But the shameful thing has devoured the labor of our fathers from our youth, their flocks and their herds, their sons and their daughters. ²⁵Let us lie down in our shame, and let our confusion cover us; for we have sinned against the LORD our God, we and our fathers, from our youth even to this day. We have not obeyed the LORD our God's voice."

⁴"If you will return, Israel," says the LORD, "if you will return to me, and if you will put away your abominations out of my sight; then you will not be removed; ²and you will swear, 'As the LORD lives,' in truth, in justice, and in righteousness. The nations will bless themselves in him, and they will glory in him." ³For the LORD says to the men of Judah and to Jerusalem, "Break up your fallow ground, and don't sow among thorns. ⁴Circumcise yourselves to the LORD, and take away the foreskins of your heart, you men of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem; lest my wrath go out like fire, and burn so that no one can quench it, because of the evil of your doings. ⁵Declare in Judah, and publish in Jerusalem; and say, 'Blow the shofar in the land!' Cry aloud and say, 'Assemble yourselves! Let's go into the fortified cities!' ⁶Set up a standard toward Zion. Flee for safety! Don't wait; for I will bring evil from the north, and a great destruction." ⁷A lion has gone up from his thicket, and a destroyer of nations. He is on

his way. He has gone out from his place, to make your land desolate, that your cities be laid waste, without inhabitant. ⁸For this, clothe yourself with sackcloth, lament and wail; for the fierce anger of the LORD hasn't turned back from us. ⁹"It will happen at that day," says the LORD, "that the heart of the king will perish, along with the heart of the princes. The priests will be astonished, and the prophets will wonder." ¹⁰Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! Surely you have greatly deceived this people and Jerusalem, saying, 'You will have peace;' whereas the sword reaches to the heart." ¹¹At that time it will be said to this people and to Jerusalem, "A hot wind blows from the bare heights in the wilderness toward the daughter of my people, not to winnow, nor to cleanse. ¹²A full wind from these will come for me. Now I will also utter judgments against them." ¹³Behold, he will come up as clouds, and his chariots will be as the whirlwind. His horses are swifter than eagles. Woe to us! For we are ruined. ¹⁴Jerusalem, wash your heart from wickedness, that you may be saved. How long will your evil thoughts lodge within you? ¹⁵For a voice declares from Dan, and publishes evil from the hills of Ephraim: ¹⁶"Tell the nations, behold, publish against Jerusalem, 'Watchers come from a far country, and raise their voice against the cities of Judah. ¹⁷As keepers of a field, they are against her all around, because she has been rebellious against me,'" says the LORD. ¹⁸"Your way and your doings have brought these things to you. This is your wickedness, for it is bitter, for it reaches to your heart." ¹⁹My anguish, my anguish! I am pained at my very heart! My heart trembles within me. I can't hold my peace, because you have heard, O my soul, the sound of the shofar, the alarm of war. ²⁰Destruction on destruction is decreed, for the whole land is laid waste. Suddenly my tents are destroyed, and my curtains gone in a moment. ²¹How long will I see the standard and hear the sound of the shofar? ²²"For my people are foolish. They don't know me. They are foolish children, and they have no understanding. They are skillful in doing evil, but they don't know how to do good." ²³I saw the earth and, behold, it was waste and void, and the heavens, and they had no light. ²⁴I saw the mountains, and behold, they trembled, and all the hills moved back and forth. ²⁵I saw, and behold, there was no man, and all the birds of the sky had fled. ²⁶I saw, and behold, the fruitful field was a wilderness, and all its cities were broken down at the presence of the LORD, before his fierce anger. ²⁷For the LORD says, "The whole land will be a desolation; yet I will not make a full end. ²⁸For this the earth will mourn, and the heavens above be black, because I have spoken it. I have planned it, and I have not repented, neither will I turn back from it." ²⁹Every city flees for the noise of the horsemen and archers. They go into the thickets and climb up on the rocks. Every city is forsaken, and not a man dwells therein. ³⁰You, when you are made desolate, what will you do? Though you clothe

yourself with scarlet, though you deck yourself with ornaments of gold, though you enlarge your eyes with makeup, you make yourself beautiful in vain. Your lovers despise you. They seek your life. ³¹For I have heard a voice as of a woman in travail, the anguish as of her who gives birth to her first child, the voice of the daughter of Zion, who gasps for breath, who spreads her hands, saying, "Woe is me now! For my soul faints before the murderers."

⁵"Run back and forth through the streets of Jerusalem, and see now, and know, and seek in its wide places, if you can find a man, if there is anyone who does justly, who seeks truth, then I will pardon her. ²Though they say, 'As the LORD lives,' surely they swear falsely." ³O LORD, don't your eyes look on truth? You have stricken them, but they were not grieved. You have consumed them, but they have refused to receive correction. They have made their faces harder than a rock. They have refused to return. ⁴Then I said, "Surely these are poor. They are foolish; for they don't know the LORD's way, nor the law of their God. ⁵I will go to the great men and will speak to them, for they know the way of the LORD, and the law of their God." But these with one accord have broken the yoke, and burst the bonds. ⁶Therefore a lion out of the forest will kill them. A wolf of the evenings will destroy them. A leopard will watch against their cities. Everyone who goes out there will be torn in pieces, because their transgressions are many and their backsliding has increased. ⁷"How can I pardon you? Your children have forsaken me, and sworn by what are no gods. When I had fed them to the full, they committed adultery, and assembled themselves in troops at the prostitutes' houses. ⁸They were as fed horses roaming at large. Everyone neighed after his neighbor's wife. ⁹Shouldn't I punish them for these things?" says the LORD. "Shouldn't my soul be avenged on such a nation as this? ¹⁰"Go up on her walls, and destroy, but don't make a full end. Take away her branches, for they are not the LORD's. ¹¹For the house of Israel and the house of Judah have dealt very treacherously against me," says the LORD. ¹²They have denied the LORD, and said, "It is not he. Evil won't come on us. We won't see sword or famine. ¹³The prophets will become wind, and the word is not in them. Thus it will be done to them." ¹⁴Therefore the LORD, the God of Hosts says, "Because you speak this word, behold, I will make my words in your mouth fire, and this people wood, and it will devour them. ¹⁵Behold, I will bring a nation on you from far away, house of Israel," says the LORD. "It is a mighty nation. It is an ancient nation, a nation whose language you don't know and don't understand what they say. ¹⁶Their quiver is an open tomb. They are all mighty men. ¹⁷They will eat up your harvest and your bread, which your sons and your daughters should eat. They will eat up your flocks and your herds. They will eat up your vines and your fig trees. They will beat down your

fortified cities in which you trust with the sword. ¹⁸"But even in those days," says the LORD, "I will not make a full end of you. ¹⁹It will happen when you say, 'Why has the LORD our God done all these things to us?' Then you shall say to them, 'Just as you have forsaken me and served foreign gods in your land, so you will serve strangers in a land that is not yours.' ²⁰"Declare this in the house of Jacob, and publish it in Judah, saying, ²¹"Hear this now, foolish people without understanding, who have eyes, and don't see, who have ears, and don't hear: ²²"Don't you fear me?" says the LORD "Won't you tremble at my presence, who have placed the sand for the bound of the sea by a perpetual decree, that it can't pass it? Though its waves toss themselves, yet they can't prevail. Though they roar, they still can't pass over it.' ²³"But this people has a revolting and a rebellious heart. They have revolted and gone. ²⁴They don't say in their heart, 'Let's now fear the LORD our God, who gives rain, both the former and the latter, in its season, who preserves to us the appointed weeks of the harvest.' ²⁵"Your iniquities have turned away these things, and your sins have withheld good from you. ²⁶For wicked men are found among my people. They watch, as fowls lie in wait. They set a trap. They catch men. ²⁷As a cage is full of birds, so are their houses full of deceit. Therefore they have become great, and grew rich. ²⁸They have grown fat. They shine; yes, they excel in deeds of wickedness. They don't plead the cause, the cause of the fatherless, that they may prosper; and they don't defend the rights of the needy. ²⁹"Shouldn't I punish for these things?" says the LORD. "Shouldn't my soul be avenged on such a nation as this? ³⁰"An astonishing and horrible thing has happened in the land. ³¹The prophets prophesy falsely, and the priests rule by their own authority; and my people love to have it so. What will you do in the end of it?

⁶"Flee for safety, you children of Benjamin, out of the middle of Jerusalem! Blow the shofar in Tekoa and raise up a signal on Beth Haccherem, for evil looks out from the north with a great destruction. ²I will cut off the beautiful and delicate one, the daughter of Zion. ³Shepherds with their flocks will come to her. They will pitch their tents against her all around. They will feed everyone in his place." ⁴"Prepare war against her! Arise! Let's go up at noon. Woe to us! For the day declines, for the shadows of the evening are stretched out. ⁵Arise! Let's go up by night, and let's destroy her palaces." ⁶For the LORD of Hosts said, "Cut down trees, and cast up a mound against Jerusalem. This is the city to be visited. She is filled with oppression within herself. ⁷As a well produces its waters, so she produces her wickedness. Violence and destruction is heard in her. Sickness and wounds are continually before me. ⁸Be instructed, Jerusalem, lest my soul be alienated from you, lest I make you a deso-

lation, an uninhabited land.” ⁹The LORD of Hosts says, “They will thoroughly glean the remnant of Israel like a vine. Turn again your hand as a grape gatherer into the baskets.” ¹⁰To whom should I speak and testify, that they may hear? Behold, their ear is uncircumcised, and they can’t listen. Behold, the LORD’s word has become a reproach to them. They have no delight in it. ¹¹Therefore I am full of the LORD’s wrath. I am weary with holding it in. “Pour it out on the children in the street, and on the assembly of young men together; for even the husband with the wife will be taken, the aged with him who is full of days. ¹²Their houses will be turned to others, their fields and their wives together; for I will stretch out my hand on the inhabitants of the land, says the LORD.” ¹³“For from their least even to their greatest, everyone is given to covetousness. From the prophet even to the priest, everyone deals falsely. ¹⁴They have healed also the hurt of my people superficially, saying, ‘Peace, peace!’ when there is no peace. ¹⁵Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? No, they were not at all ashamed, neither could they blush. Therefore they will fall among those who fall. When I visit them, they will be cast down,” says the LORD. ¹⁶The LORD says, “Stand in the ways and see, and ask for the old paths, ‘Where is the good way?’ and walk in it, and you will find rest for your souls. But they said, ‘We will not walk in it.’ ¹⁷I set watchmen over you, saying, ‘Listen to the sound of the shofar!’ But they said, ‘We will not listen!’ ¹⁸Therefore hear, you nations, and know, congregation, what is among them. ¹⁹Hear, earth! Behold, I will bring evil on this people, even the fruit of their thoughts, because they have not listened to my words; and as for my law, they have rejected it. ²⁰To what purpose does frankincense from Sheba come to me, and the sweet cane from a far country? Your burnt offerings are not acceptable, and your sacrifices are not pleasing to me.” ²¹Therefore The LORD says, “Behold, I will lay stumbling blocks before this people. The fathers and the sons together will stumble against them. The neighbor and his friend will perish.” ²²The LORD says, “Behold, a people comes from the north country. A great nation will be stirred up from the uttermost parts of the earth. ²³They take hold of bow and spear. They are cruel, and have no mercy. Their voice roars like the sea, and they ride on horses, everyone set in array, as a man to the battle, against you, daughter of Zion.” ²⁴We have heard its report. Our hands become feeble. Anguish has taken hold of us, and pains as of a woman in labor. ²⁵Don’t go out into the field or walk by the way; for the sword of the enemy and terror are on every side. ²⁶Daughter of my people, clothe yourself with sackcloth, and wallow in ashes! Mourn, as for an only son, most bitter lamentation, for the destroyer will suddenly come on us. ²⁷“I have made you a tester of metals and a fortress among my people, that you may know and try their way. ²⁸They are all grievous rebels,

going around to slander. They are bronze and iron. All of them deal corruptly. ²⁹The bellows blow fiercely. The lead is consumed in the fire. In vain they go on refining, for the wicked are not plucked away. ³⁰Men will call them rejected silver, because the LORD has rejected them.”

7 The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²“Stand in the gate of the LORD’s house, and proclaim this word there, and say, ‘Hear the LORD’s word, all you of Judah, who enter in at these gates to worship the LORD.’” ³The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says, “Amend your ways and your doings, and I will cause you to dwell in this place. ⁴Don’t trust in lying words, saying, ‘The LORD’s temple, the LORD’s temple, the LORD’s temple, are these.’ ⁵For if you thoroughly amend your ways and your doings, if you thoroughly execute justice between a man and his neighbor; ⁶if you don’t oppress the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow, and don’t shed innocent blood in this place, and don’t walk after other gods to your own hurt, ⁷then I will cause you to dwell in this place, in the land that I gave to your fathers, from of old even forever more. ⁸Behold, you trust in lying words that can’t profit. ⁹Will you steal, murder, commit adultery, swear falsely, burn incense to Baal, and walk after other gods that you have not known, ¹⁰then come and stand before me in this house, which is called by my name, and say, ‘We are delivered,’ that you may do all these abominations? ¹¹Has this house, which is called by my name, become a den of robbers in your eyes? Behold, I myself have seen it,” says the LORD. ¹²“But go now to my place which was in Shiloh, where I caused my name to dwell at the first, and see what I did to it for the wickedness of my people Israel. ¹³Now, because you have done all these works,” says the LORD, “and I spoke to you, rising up early and speaking, but you didn’t hear; and I called you, but you didn’t answer; ¹⁴therefore I will do to the house which is called by my name, in which you trust, and to the place which I gave to you and to your fathers, as I did to Shiloh. ¹⁵I will cast you out of my sight, as I have cast out all your brothers, even the whole offspring ^{vi} of Ephraim. ¹⁶“Therefore don’t pray for this people. Don’t lift up a cry or prayer for them or make intercession to me; for I will not hear you. ¹⁷Don’t you see what they do in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem? ¹⁸The children gather wood, and the fathers kindle the fire, and the women knead the dough, to make cakes to the queen of the sky, and to pour out drink offerings to other gods, that they may provoke me to anger. ¹⁹Do they provoke me to anger?” says the LORD. “Don’t they provoke themselves, to the confusion of their own faces?” ²⁰Therefore the Lord GOD says: “Behold, my anger and my wrath will be poured out on this place, on man, on animal, on the trees of the field, and on the fruit of the ground; and

^{vi}or, seed

it will burn and will not be quenched.” ²¹the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: “Add your burnt offerings to your sacrifices and eat meat. ²²For I didn’t speak to your fathers or command them in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt concerning burnt offerings or sacrifices; ²³but this thing I commanded them, saying, ‘Listen to my voice, and I will be your God, and you shall be my people. Walk in all the way that I command you, that it may be well with you.’ ²⁴But they didn’t listen or turn their ear, but walked in their own counsels and in the stubbornness of their evil heart, and went backward, and not forward. ²⁵Since the day that your fathers came out of the land of Egypt to this day, I have sent to you all my servants the prophets, daily rising up early and sending them. ²⁶Yet they didn’t listen to me or incline their ear, but made their neck stiff. They did worse than their fathers. ²⁷“You shall speak all these words to them, but they will not listen to you. You shall also call to them, but they will not answer you. ²⁸You shall tell them, ‘This is the nation that has not listened to the LORD their God’s voice, nor received instruction. Truth has perished, and is cut off from their mouth.’ ²⁹Cut off your hair, and throw it away, and take up a lamentation on the bare heights; for the LORD has rejected and forsaken the generation of his wrath. ³⁰“For the children of Judah have done that which is evil in my sight,” says the LORD. “They have set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to defile it. ³¹They have built the high places of Topheth, which is in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire, which I didn’t command, nor did it come into my mind. ³²Therefore behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that it will no more be called ‘Topheth’ or ‘The valley of the son of Hinnom’, but ‘The valley of Slaughter’; for they will bury in Topheth until there is no place to bury. ³³The dead bodies of this people will be food for the birds of the sky, and for the animals of the earth. No one will frighten them away. ³⁴Then I will cause to cease from the cities of Judah and from the streets of Jerusalem the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride; for the land will become a waste.”

⁸“At that time,” says the LORD, “they will bring the bones of the kings of Judah, the bones of his princes, the bones of the priests, the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, out of their graves. ²They will spread them before the sun, the moon, and all the army of the sky, which they have loved, which they have served, after which they have walked, which they have sought, and which they have worshiped. They will not be gathered or be buried. They will be like dung on the surface of the earth. ³Death will be chosen rather than life by all the residue that remain of this evil family, that remain in all the places where I have driven them,” says

the LORD of Hosts. ⁴“Moreover you shall tell them, ‘The LORD says: “‘Do men fall, and not rise up again? Does one turn away, and not return? ⁵Why then have the people of Jerusalem fallen back by a perpetual backsliding? They cling to deceit. They refuse to return. ⁶I listened and heard, but they didn’t say what is right. No one repents of his wickedness, saying, “What have I done?” Everyone turns to his course, as a horse that rushes headlong in the battle. ⁷Yes, the stork in the sky knows her appointed times. The turtledove, the swallow, and the crane observe the time of their coming; but my people don’t know the LORD’s law. ⁸“How do you say, “We are wise, and the LORD’s law is with us?” But, behold, the false pen of the scribes has made that a lie. ⁹The wise men are disappointed. They are dismayed and trapped. Behold, they have rejected the LORD’s word. What kind of wisdom is in them? ¹⁰Therefore I will give their wives to others and their fields to those who will possess them. For everyone from the least even to the greatest is given to covetousness; from the prophet even to the priest everyone deals falsely. ¹¹They have healed the hurt of the daughter of my people slightly, saying, “Peace, peace,” when there is no peace. ¹²Were they ashamed when they had committed abomination? No, they were not at all ashamed. They couldn’t blush. Therefore they will fall among those who fall. In the time of their visitation they will be cast down, says the LORD. ¹³“I will utterly consume them, says the LORD. No grapes will be on the vine, no figs on the fig tree, and the leaf will fade. The things that I have given them will pass away from them.” ¹⁴“Why do we sit still? Assemble yourselves! Let’s enter into the fortified cities, and let’s be silent there; for the LORD our God has put us to silence, and given us poisoned water to drink, because we have sinned against the LORD. ¹⁵We looked for peace, but no good came; and for a time of healing, and behold, dismay! ¹⁶The snorting of his horses is heard from Dan. The whole land trembles at the sound of the neighing of his strong ones; for they have come, and have devoured the land and all that is in it, the city and those who dwell therein.” ¹⁷“For, behold, I will send serpents, adders among you, which will not be charmed; and they will bite you,” says the LORD. ¹⁸Oh that I could comfort myself against sorrow! My heart is faint within me. ¹⁹Behold, the voice of the cry of the daughter of my people from a land that is very far off: “Isn’t the LORD in Zion? Isn’t her King in her?” “Why have they provoked me to anger with their engraved images, and with foreign idols?” ²⁰“The harvest is past. The summer has ended, and we are not saved.” ²¹For the hurt of the daughter of my people, I am hurt. I mourn. Dismay has taken hold of me. ²²Is there no balm in Gilead? Is there no physician there? Why then isn’t the health of the daughter of my people recovered?

⁹Oh that my head were waters, and my eyes a spring of

tears, that I might weep day and night for the slain of the daughter of my people! ²Oh that I had in the wilderness a lodging place of wayfaring men, that I might leave my people and go from them! For they are all adulterers, an assembly of treacherous men. ³"They bend their tongue, as their bow, for falsehood. They have grown strong in the land, but not for truth; for they proceed from evil to evil, and they don't know me," says the LORD. ⁴"Everyone beware of his neighbor, and don't trust in any brother; for every brother will utterly supplant, and every neighbor will go around like a slanderer. ⁵Friends deceive each other, and will not speak the truth. They have taught their tongue to speak lies. They weary themselves committing iniquity. ⁶Your habitation is in the middle of deceit. Through deceit, they refuse to know me," says the LORD. ⁷Therefore the LORD of Hosts says, "Behold, I will melt them and test them; for how should I deal with the daughter of my people? ⁸Their tongue is a deadly arrow. It speaks deceit. One speaks peaceably to his neighbor with his mouth, but in his heart, he waits to ambush him. ⁹Shouldn't I punish them for these things?" says the LORD. "Shouldn't my soul be avenged on a nation such as this? ¹⁰I will weep and wail for the mountains, and lament for the pastures of the wilderness, because they are burned up, so that no one passes through; Men can't hear the voice of the livestock. Both the birds of the sky and the animals have fled. They are gone. ¹¹"I will make Jerusalem heaps, a dwelling place of jackals. I will make the cities of Judah a desolation, without inhabitant." ¹²Who is wise enough to understand this? Who is he to whom the mouth of the LORD has spoken, that he may declare it? Why has the land perished and burned up like a wilderness, so that no one passes through? ¹³The LORD says, "Because they have forsaken my law which I set before them, and have not obeyed my voice or walked in my ways, ¹⁴but have walked after the stubbornness of their own heart and after the Baals, which their fathers taught them." ¹⁵Therefore the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says, "Behold, I will feed them, even this people, with wormwood and give them poisoned water to drink. ¹⁶I will scatter them also among the nations, whom neither they nor their fathers have known. I will send the sword after them, until I have consumed them." ¹⁷The LORD of Hosts says, "Consider, and call for the mourning women, that they may come. Send for the skillful women, that they may come. ¹⁸Let them make haste and take up a wailing for us, that our eyes may run down with tears and our eyelids gush out with waters. ¹⁹For a voice of wailing is heard out of Zion, 'How we are ruined! We are greatly confounded because we have forsaken the land, because they have cast down our dwellings.'" ²⁰Yet hear the LORD's word, you women. Let your ear receive the word of his mouth. Teach your daughters wailing. Everyone teach her neighbor a lamentation. ²¹For death has come up into our windows. It has

entered into our palaces to cut off the children from outside, and the young men from the streets. ²²Speak, "The LORD says, "'The dead bodies of men will fall as dung on the open field, and as the handful after the harvester. No one will gather them.'" ²³The LORD says, "Don't let the wise man glory in his wisdom. Don't let the mighty man glory in his might. Don't let the rich man glory in his riches. ²⁴But let him who glories glory in this, that he has understanding, and knows me, that I am the LORD who exercises loving kindness, justice, and righteousness in the earth, for I delight in these things," says the LORD. ²⁵"Behold, the days come," says the LORD, "that I will punish all those who are circumcised only in their flesh: ²⁶Egypt, Judah, Edom, the children of Ammon, Moab, and all who have the corners of their hair cut off, who dwell in the wilderness, for all the nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in heart."

10 Hear the word which the LORD speaks to you, house of Israel! ²The LORD says, "Don't learn the way of the nations, and don't be dismayed at the signs of the sky; for the nations are dismayed at them. ³For the customs of the peoples are vanity; for one cuts a tree out of the forest, the work of the hands of the workman with the ax. ⁴They deck it with silver and with gold. They fasten it with nails and with hammers, so that it can't move. ⁵They are like a palm tree, of turned work, and don't speak. They must be carried, because they can't move. Don't be afraid of them; for they can't do evil, neither is it in them to do good." ⁶There is no one like you, LORD. You are great, and your name is great in might. ⁷Who shouldn't fear you, King of the nations? For it belongs to you. Because among all the wise men of the nations, and in all their royal estate, there is no one like you. ⁸But they are together brutish and foolish, instructed by idols! It is just wood. ⁹There is silver beaten into plates, which is brought from Tarshish, and gold from Uphaz, the work of the engraver and of the hands of the goldsmith. Their clothing is blue and purple. They are all the work of skillful men. ¹⁰But the LORD is the true God. He is the living God, and an everlasting King. At his wrath, the earth trembles. The nations aren't able to withstand his indignation. ¹¹"You shall say this to them: 'The gods that have not made the heavens and the earth will perish from the earth, and from under the heavens.'" ¹²God has made the earth by his power. He has established the world by his wisdom, and by his understanding has he stretched out the heavens. ¹³When he utters his voice, the waters in the heavens roar, and he causes the vapors to ascend from the ends of the earth. He makes lightnings for the rain, and brings the wind out of his treasures. ¹⁴Every man has become brutish and without knowledge. Every goldsmith is disappointed by his engraved image; for his molten image is falsehood, and there is no breath in them. ¹⁵They are vanity, a work of delusion. In the time of their

visitation they will perish. ¹⁶The portion of Jacob is not like these; for he is the maker of all things; and Israel is the tribe of his inheritance. The LORD of Hosts is his name. ¹⁷Gather up your wares out of the land, you who live under siege. ¹⁸For the LORD says, "Behold, I will sling out the inhabitants of the land at this time, and will distress them, that they may feel it." ¹⁹Woe is me because of my injury! My wound is serious; but I said, "Truly this is my grief, and I must bear it." ²⁰My tent has been destroyed, and all my cords are broken. My children have gone away from me, and they are no more. There is no one to spread my tent any more, to set up my curtains. ²¹For the shepherds have become brutish, and have not inquired of the LORD. Therefore they have not prospered, and all their flocks have scattered. ²²The voice of news, behold, it comes, and a great commotion out of the north country, to make the cities of Judah a desolation, a dwelling place of jackals. ²³LORD, I know that the way of man is not in himself. It is not in man who walks to direct his steps. ²⁴LORD, correct me, but gently; not in your anger, lest you reduce me to nothing. ²⁵Pour out your wrath on the nations that don't know you, and on the families that don't call on your name; for they have devoured Jacob. Yes, they have devoured him, consumed him, and have laid waste his habitation.

11The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²"Hear the words of this covenant, and speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem; ³and say to them, the LORD, the God of Israel says: 'Cursed is the man who doesn't hear the words of this covenant, ⁴which I commanded your fathers in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, out of the iron furnace,' saying, 'Obey my voice and do them, according to all which I command you; so you shall be my people, and I will be your God; ⁵that I may establish the oath which I swore to your fathers, to give them a land flowing with milk and honey,' as it is today." Then I answered, and said, "Amen, LORD." ⁶The LORD said to me, "Proclaim all these words in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, saying, 'Hear the words of this covenant, and do them. ⁷For I earnestly protested to your fathers in the day that I brought them up out of the land of Egypt, even to this day, rising early and protesting, saying, "Obey my voice." ⁸Yet they didn't obey, nor turn their ear, but everyone walked in the stubbornness of their evil heart. Therefore I brought on them all the words of this covenant, which I commanded them to do, but they didn't do them.'" ⁹The LORD said to me, "A conspiracy is found among the men of Judah, and among the inhabitants of Jerusalem. ¹⁰They have turned back to the iniquities of their forefathers, who refused to hear my words. They have gone after other gods to serve them. The house of Israel and the house of Judah have broken my covenant which I made with their fathers.

¹¹Therefore the LORD says, 'Behold, I will bring evil on them which they will not be able to escape; and they will cry to me, but I will not listen to them. ¹²Then the cities of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem will go and cry to the gods to which they offer incense, but they will not save them at all in the time of their trouble. ¹³For according to the number of your cities are your gods, Judah; and according to the number of the streets of Jerusalem you have set up altars to the shameful thing, even altars to burn incense to Baal.' ¹⁴"Therefore don't pray for this people. Don't lift up cry or prayer for them; for I will not hear them in the time that they cry to me because of their trouble. ¹⁵What has my beloved to do in my house, since she has behaved lewdly with many, and the holy flesh has passed from you? When you do evil, then you rejoice." ¹⁶The LORD called your name, "A green olive tree, beautiful with goodly fruit." With the noise of a great roar he has kindled fire on it, and its branches are broken. ¹⁷For the LORD of Hosts, who planted you, has pronounced evil against you, because of the evil of the house of Israel and of the house of Judah, which they have done to themselves in provoking me to anger by offering incense to Baal. ¹⁸The LORD gave me knowledge of it, and I knew it. Then you showed me their doings. ¹⁹But I was like a gentle lamb that is led to the slaughter. I didn't know that they had devised plans against me, saying, "Let's destroy the tree with its fruit, and let's cut him off from the land of the living, that his name may be no more remembered." ²⁰But, the LORD of Hosts, who judges righteously, who tests the heart and the mind, I will see your vengeance on them; for to you I have revealed my cause. ²¹"Therefore the LORD says concerning the men of Anathoth, who seek your life, saying, 'You shall not prophesy in the LORD's name, that you not die by our hand'— ²²therefore the LORD of Hosts says, 'Behold, I will punish them. The young men will die by the sword. Their sons and their daughters will die by famine. ²³There will be no remnant to them, for I will bring evil on the men of Anathoth, even the year of their visitation.'

12You are righteous, LORD, when I contend with you; yet I would like to plead a case with you. Why does the way of the wicked prosper? Why are they all at ease who deal very treacherously? ²You have planted them. Yes, they have taken root. They grow. Yes, they produce fruit. You are near in their mouth, and far from their heart. ³But you, LORD, know me. You see me, and test my heart toward you. Pull them out like sheep for the slaughter, and prepare them for the day of slaughter. ⁴How long will the land mourn, and the herbs of the whole country wither? Because of the wickedness of those who dwell therein, the animals and birds are consumed; because they said, "He won't see our latter end." ⁵"If you have run with the footmen, and they have wearied you, then how can you contend

with horses? Though in a land of peace you are secure, yet how will you do in the pride of the Jordan? ⁶For even your brothers, and the house of your father, even they have dealt treacherously with you! Even they have cried aloud after you! Don't believe them, though they speak beautiful words to you. ⁷"I have forsaken my house. I have cast off my heritage. I have given the dearly beloved of my soul into the hand of her enemies. ⁸My heritage has become to me as a lion in the forest. She has uttered her voice against me. Therefore I have hated her. ⁹Is my heritage to me as a speckled bird of prey? Are the birds of prey against her all around? Go, assemble all the animals of the field. Bring them to devour. ¹⁰Many shepherds have destroyed my vineyard. They have trodden my portion under foot. They have made my pleasant portion a desolate wilderness. ¹¹They have made it a desolation. It mourns to me, being desolate. The whole land is made desolate, because no one cares. ¹²Destroyers have come on all the bare heights in the wilderness; for the sword of the LORD devours from the one end of the land even to the other end of the land. No flesh has peace. ¹³They have sown wheat, and have reaped thorns. They have exhausted themselves, and profit nothing. You will be ashamed of your fruits, because of the LORD's fierce anger." ¹⁴The LORD says, "Concerning all my evil neighbors, who touch the inheritance which I have caused my people Israel to inherit: Behold, I will pluck them up from off their land, and will pluck up the house of Judah from among them. ¹⁵It will happen that after I have plucked them up, I will return and have compassion on them. I will bring them again, every man to his heritage, and every man to his land. ¹⁶It will happen, if they will diligently learn the ways of my people, to swear by my name, 'As the LORD lives;' even as they taught my people to swear by Baal, then they will be built up in the middle of my people. ¹⁷But if they will not hear, then I will pluck up that nation, plucking up and destroying it," says the LORD.

13The LORD said to me, "Go, and buy yourself a linen belt, and put it on your waist, and don't put it in water." ²So I bought a belt according to the LORD's word, and put it on my waist. ³The LORD's word came to me the second time, saying, ⁴"Take the belt that you have bought, which is on your waist, and arise, go to the Euphrates, and hide it there in a cleft of the rock." ⁵So I went and hid it by the Euphrates, as the LORD commanded me. ⁶After many days, the LORD said to me, "Arise, go to the Euphrates, and take the belt from there, which I commanded you to hide there." ⁷Then I went to the Euphrates, and dug, and took the belt from the place where I had hidden it; and behold, the belt was ruined. It was profitable for nothing. ⁸Then the LORD's word came to me, saying, ⁹"The LORD says, 'In this way I will ruin the pride of Judah, and the great pride of Jerusalem. ¹⁰This evil people, who

refuse to hear my words, who walk in the stubbornness of their heart, and have gone after other gods to serve them and to worship them, will even be as this belt, which is profitable for nothing. ¹¹For as the belt clings to the waist of a man, so I have caused the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah to cling to me,' says the LORD; 'that they may be to me for a people, for a name, for praise, and for glory; but they would not hear.' ¹²"Therefore you shall speak to them this word: 'The LORD, the God of Israel says, "Every container should be filled with wine."' They will tell you, 'Do we not certainly know that every container should be filled with wine?' ¹³Then tell them, 'The LORD says, "Behold, I will fill all the inhabitants of this land, even the kings who sit on David's throne, the priests, the prophets, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, with drunkenness. ¹⁴I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together," says the LORD: "I will not pity, spare, or have compassion, that I should not destroy them."' ¹⁵Hear, and give ear. Don't be proud, for the LORD has spoken. ¹⁶Give glory to the LORD your God, before he causes darkness, and before your feet stumble on the dark mountains, and while you look for light, he turns it into the shadow of death, and makes it deep darkness. ¹⁷But if you will not hear it, my soul will weep in secret for your pride. My eye will weep bitterly, and run down with tears, because the LORD's flock has been taken captive. ¹⁸Say to the king and to the queen mother, "Humble yourselves. Sit down, for your crowns have come down, even the crown of your glory. ¹⁹The cities of the South are shut up, and there is no one to open them. Judah is carried away captive: all of them. They are wholly carried away captive. ²⁰Lift up your eyes, and see those who come from the north. Where is the flock that was given to you, your beautiful flock? ²¹What will you say when he sets over you as head those whom you have yourself taught to be friends to you? Won't sorrows take hold of you, as of a woman in travail? ²²If you say in your heart, "Why have these things come on me?" Your skirts are uncovered because of the greatness of your iniquity, and your heels suffer violence. ²³Can the Ethiopian change his skin, or the leopard his spots? Then may you also do good, who are accustomed to do evil. ²⁴"Therefore I will scatter them as the stubble that passes away by the wind of the wilderness. ²⁵This is your lot, the portion measured to you from me," says the LORD, "because you have forgotten me, and trusted in falsehood." ²⁶Therefore I will also uncover your skirts on your face, and your shame will appear. ²⁷I have seen your abominations, even your adulteries and your neighing, the lewdness of your prostitution, on the hills in the field. Woe to you, Jerusalem! You will not be made clean. How long will it yet be?"

14This is the LORD's word that came to Jeremiah concerning the drought: ²"Judah mourns, and its gates

languish. They sit in black on the ground. The cry of Jerusalem goes up. ³Their nobles send their little ones to the waters. They come to the cisterns, and find no water. They return with their vessels empty. They are disappointed and confounded, and cover their heads. ⁴Because of the ground which is cracked, because no rain has been in the land, the plowmen are disappointed. They cover their heads. ⁵Yes, the doe in the field also calves and forsakes her young, because there is no grass. ⁶The wild donkeys stand on the bare heights. They pant for air like jackals. Their eyes fail, because there is no vegetation. ⁷Though our iniquities testify against us, work for your name's sake, LORD; for our rebellions are many. We have sinned against you. ⁸You hope of Israel, its Savior in the time of trouble, why should you be as a foreigner in the land, and as a way-faring man who turns aside to stay for a night? ⁹Why should you be like a scared man, as a mighty man who can't save? Yet you, LORD, are in the middle of us, and we are called by your name. Don't leave us. ¹⁰The LORD says to this people: "Even so they have loved to wander. They have not restrained their feet. Therefore the LORD does not accept them. Now he will remember their iniquity, and punish them for their sins." ¹¹The LORD said to me, "Don't pray for this people for their good. ¹²When they fast, I will not hear their cry; and when they offer burnt offering and meal offering, I will not accept them; but I will consume them by the sword, by famine, and by pestilence." ¹³Then I said, "Ah, Lord GOD! Behold, the prophets tell them, 'You will not see the sword, neither will you have famine; but I will give you assured peace in this place.'" ¹⁴Then the LORD said to me, "The prophets prophesy lies in my name. I didn't send them. I didn't command them. I didn't speak to them. They prophesy to you a lying vision, divination, and a thing of nothing, and the deceit of their own heart. ¹⁵Therefore the LORD says concerning the prophets who prophesy in my name, but I didn't send them, yet they say, 'Sword and famine will not be in this land.' Those prophets will be consumed by sword and famine. ¹⁶The people to whom they prophesy will be cast out in the streets of Jerusalem because of the famine and the sword. They will have no one to bury them—they, their wives, their sons, or their daughters, for I will pour their wickedness on them. ¹⁷"You shall say this word to them: "'Let my eyes run down with tears night and day, and let them not cease; for the virgin daughter of my people is broken with a great breach, with a very grievous wound. ¹⁸If I go out into the field, then behold, the slain with the sword! If I enter into the city, then behold, those who are sick with famine! For both the prophet and the priest go about in the land, and have no knowledge.'" ¹⁹Have you utterly rejected Judah? Has your soul loathed Zion? Why have you struck us, and there is no healing for us? We looked for peace, but no good came; and for a time of healing, and behold, dismay! ²⁰We ac-

knowledge, LORD, our wickedness, and the iniquity of our fathers; for we have sinned against you. ²¹Do not abhor us, for your name's sake. Do not disgrace the throne of your glory. Remember, and don't break your covenant with us. ²²Are there any among the vanities of the nations that can cause rain? Or can the sky give showers? Aren't you he, the LORD our God? Therefore we will wait for you; for you have made all these things.

¹⁵Then the LORD said to me, "Though Moses and Samuel stood before me, yet my mind would not turn toward this people. Cast them out of my sight, and let them go out! ²It will happen when they ask you, 'Where shall we go out?' then you shall tell them, 'The LORD says: "Such as are for death, to death; such as are for the sword, to the sword; such as are for the famine, to the famine; and such as are for captivity, to captivity.'" ³"I will appoint over them four kinds," says the LORD: "the sword to kill, the dogs to tear, the birds of the sky, and the animals of the earth, to devour and to destroy. ⁴I will cause them to be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth, because of Manasseh, the son of Hezekiah, king of Judah, for that which he did in Jerusalem. ⁵For who will have pity on you, Jerusalem? Who will mourn you? Who will come to ask of your welfare? ⁶You have rejected me," says the LORD. "You have gone backward. Therefore I have stretched out my hand against you and destroyed you. I am weary of showing compassion. ⁷I have winnowed them with a fan in the gates of the land. I have bereaved them of children. I have destroyed my people. They didn't return from their ways. ⁸Their widows are increased more than the sand of the seas. I have brought on them against the mother of the young men a destroyer at noonday. I have caused anguish and terrors to fall on her suddenly. ⁹She who has borne seven languishes. She has given up the spirit. Her sun has gone down while it was yet day. She has been disappointed and confounded. I will deliver their residue to the sword before their enemies," says the LORD. ¹⁰Woe is me, my mother, that you have borne me, a man of strife, and a man of contention to the whole earth! I have not lent, neither have men lent to me; yet every one of them curses me. ¹¹The LORD said, "Most certainly I will strengthen you for good. Most certainly I will cause the enemy to make supplication to you in the time of evil and in the time of affliction. ¹²Can one break iron, even iron from the north, and bronze? ¹³I will give your substance and your treasures for a plunder without price, and that for all your sins, even in all your borders. ¹⁴I will make them to pass with your enemies into a land which you don't know; for a fire is kindled in my anger, which will burn on you." ¹⁵LORD, you know. Remember me, visit me, and avenge me of my persecutors. You are patient, so don't take me away. Know that for your sake I have suffered reproach. ¹⁶Your words were found, and I

ate them. Your words were to me a joy and the rejoicing of my heart, for I am called by your name, the LORD, God of Hosts. ¹⁷I didn't sit in the assembly of those who make merry and rejoice. I sat alone because of your hand, for you have filled me with indignation. ¹⁸Why is my pain perpetual, and my wound incurable, which refuses to be healed? Will you indeed be to me as a deceitful brook, like waters that fail? ¹⁹Therefore the LORD says, "If you return, then I will bring you again, that you may stand before me; and if you take out the precious from the vile, you will be as my mouth. They will return to you, but you will not return to them. ²⁰I will make you to this people a fortified bronze wall. They will fight against you, but they will not prevail against you; for I am with you to save you and to deliver you," says the LORD. ²¹"I will deliver you out of the hand of the wicked, and I will redeem you out of the hand of the terrible."

16Then The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"You shall not take a wife, neither shall you have sons or daughters, in this place." ³For the LORD says concerning the sons and concerning the daughters who are born in this place, and concerning their mothers who bore them, and concerning their fathers who became their father in this land: ⁴"They will die grievous deaths. They will not be lamented, neither will they be buried. They will be as dung on the surface of the ground. They will be consumed by the sword and by famine. Their dead bodies will be food for the birds of the sky and for the animals of the earth." ⁵For the LORD says, "Don't enter into the house of mourning. Don't go to lament. Don't bemoan them, for I have taken away my peace from this people," says the LORD, "even loving kindness and tender mercies. ⁶Both great and small will die in this land. They will not be buried. Men won't lament for them, cut themselves, or make themselves bald for them. ⁷Men won't break bread for them in mourning, to comfort them for the dead. Men won't give them the cup of consolation to drink for their father or for their mother. ⁸"You shall not go into the house of feasting to sit with them, to eat and to drink." ⁹For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: "Behold, I will cause to cease out of this place, before your eyes and in your days, the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride. ¹⁰It will happen, when you tell this people all these words, and they ask you, 'Why has the LORD pronounced all this great evil against us?' or 'What is our iniquity?' or 'What is our sin that we have committed against the LORD our God?' ¹¹then you shall tell them, 'Because your fathers have forsaken me,' says the LORD, 'and have walked after other gods, have served them, have worshiped them, have forsaken me, and have not kept my law. ¹²You have done evil more than your fathers, for behold, you each walk after the stubbornness of his evil heart, so that you don't listen

to me. ¹³Therefore I will cast you out of this land into the land that you have not known, neither you nor your fathers. There you will serve other gods day and night, for I will show you no favor.' ¹⁴"Therefore behold, the days come," says the LORD, "that it will no more be said, 'As the LORD lives, who brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;' ¹⁵but, 'As the LORD lives, who brought up the children of Israel from the land of the north, and from all the countries where he had driven them.' I will bring them again into their land that I gave to their fathers. ¹⁶"Behold, I will send for many fishermen," says the LORD, "and they will fish them up. Afterward I will send for many hunters, and they will hunt them from every mountain, from every hill, and out of the clefts of the rocks. ¹⁷For my eyes are on all their ways. They are not hidden from my face. Their iniquity isn't concealed from my eyes. ¹⁸First I will recompense their iniquity and their sin double, because they have polluted my land with the carcasses of their detestable things, and have filled my inheritance with their abominations." ¹⁹LORD, my strength, my stronghold, and my refuge in the day of affliction, the nations will come to you from the ends of the earth, and will say, "Our fathers have inherited nothing but lies, vanity and things in which there is no profit. ²⁰Should a man make to himself gods which yet are no gods?" ²¹"Therefore behold, I will cause them to know, this once I will cause them to know my hand and my might. Then they will know that my name is the LORD."

17"The sin of Judah is written with a pen of iron, and with the point of a diamond. It is engraved on the tablet of their heart, and on the horns of your altars. ²Even their children remember their altars and their Asherah poles by the green trees on the high hills. ³My mountain in the field, I will give your substance and all your treasures for a plunder, and your high places, because of sin, throughout all your borders. ⁴You, even of yourself, will discontinue from your heritage that I gave you. I will cause you to serve your enemies in the land which you don't know, for you have kindled a fire in my anger which will burn forever." ⁵The LORD says: "Cursed is the man who trusts in man, relies on strength of flesh, and whose heart departs from the LORD. ⁶For he will be like a bush in the desert, and will not see when good comes, but will inhabit the parched places in the wilderness, an uninhabited salt land. ⁷"Blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, and whose confidence is in the LORD. ⁸For he will be as a tree planted by the waters, who spreads out its roots by the river, and will not fear when heat comes, but its leaf will be green, and will not be concerned in the year of drought. It won't cease from yielding fruit. ⁹The heart is deceitful above all things and it is exceedingly corrupt. Who can know it? ¹⁰"I, the LORD, search the mind. I try the heart, even to give every man according to his ways, according

to the fruit of his doings.” ¹¹As the partridge that sits on eggs which she has not laid, so is he who gets riches, and not by right. In the middle of his days, they will leave him. At his end, he will be a fool. ¹²A glorious throne, set on high from the beginning, is the place of our sanctuary. ¹³LORD, the hope of Israel, all who forsake you will be disappointed. Those who depart from me will be written in the earth, because they have forsaken the LORD, the spring of living waters. ¹⁴Heal me, O LORD, and I will be healed. Save me, and I will be saved; for you are my praise. ¹⁵Behold, they ask me, “Where is the LORD’s word? Let it be fulfilled now.” ¹⁶As for me, I have not hurried from being a shepherd after you. I haven’t desired the woeful day. You know. That which came out of my lips was before your face. ¹⁷Don’t be a terror to me. You are my refuge in the day of evil. ¹⁸Let them be disappointed who persecute me, but don’t let me be disappointed. Let them be dismayed, but don’t let me be dismayed. Bring on them the day of evil, and destroy them with double destruction. ¹⁹The LORD said this to me: “Go and stand in the gate of the children of the people, through which the kings of Judah come in and by which they go out, and in all the gates of Jerusalem. ²⁰Tell them, ‘Hear the LORD’s word, you kings of Judah, all Judah, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, that enter in by these gates: ²¹The LORD says, ‘Be careful, and bear no burden on the Sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of Jerusalem. ²²Don’t carry a burden out of your houses on the Sabbath day. Don’t do any work, but make the Sabbath day holy, as I commanded your fathers. ²³But they didn’t listen. They didn’t turn their ear, but made their neck stiff, that they might not hear, and might not receive instruction. ²⁴It will happen, if you diligently listen to me,” says the LORD, “to bring in no burden through the gates of this city on the Sabbath day, but to make the Sabbath day holy, to do no work therein; ²⁵then there will enter in by the gates of this city kings and princes sitting on David’s throne, riding in chariots and on horses, they and their princes, the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and this city will remain forever. ²⁶They will come from the cities of Judah, and from the places around Jerusalem, from the land of Benjamin, from the lowland, from the hill country, and from the South, bringing burnt offerings, sacrifices, meal offerings, and frankincense, and bringing sacrifices of thanksgiving to the LORD’s house. ²⁷But if you will not listen to me to make the Sabbath day holy, and not to bear a burden and enter in at the gates of Jerusalem on the Sabbath day, then I will kindle a fire in its gates, and it will devour the palaces of Jerusalem. It will not be quenched.’”

¹⁸The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²“Arise, and go down to the potter’s house, and there I will cause you to hear my words.” ³Then I went

down to the potter’s house, and behold, he was making something on the wheels. ⁴When the vessel that he made of the clay was marred in the hand of the potter, he made it again another vessel, as seemed good to the potter to make it. ⁵Then the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ⁶“House of Israel, can’t I do with you as this potter?” says the LORD. “Behold, as the clay in the potter’s hand, so are you in my hand, house of Israel. ⁷At the instant I speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to pluck up and to break down and to destroy it, ⁸if that nation, concerning which I have spoken, turns from their evil, I will repent of the evil that I thought to do to them. ⁹At the instant I speak concerning a nation, and concerning a kingdom, to build and to plant it, ¹⁰if they do that which is evil in my sight, that they not obey my voice, then I will repent of the good with which I said I would benefit them. ¹¹“Now therefore, speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, saying, ‘The LORD says: “Behold, I frame evil against you, and devise a plan against you. Everyone return from his evil way now, and amend your ways and your doings.”’ ¹²But they say, ‘It is in vain; for we will walk after our own plans, and we will each follow the stubbornness of his evil heart.’” ¹³Therefore the LORD says: “Ask now among the nations, ‘Who has heard such things?’ The virgin of Israel has done a very horrible thing. ¹⁴Will the snow of Lebanon fail from the rock of the field? Will the cold waters that flow down from afar be dried up? ¹⁵For my people have forgotten me. They have burned incense to false gods. They have been made to stumble in their ways in the ancient paths, to walk in byways, in a way not built up, ¹⁶to make their land an astonishment, and a perpetual hissing. Everyone who passes by it will be astonished, and shake his head. ¹⁷I will scatter them as with an east wind before the enemy. I will show them the back, and not the face, in the day of their calamity. ¹⁸Then they said, “Come! Let’s devise plans against Jeremiah; for the law won’t perish from the priest, nor counsel from the wise, nor the word from the prophet. Come, and let’s strike him with the tongue, and let’s not give heed to any of his words.” ¹⁹Give heed to me, LORD, and listen to the voice of those who contend with me. ²⁰Should evil be recompensed for good? For they have dug a pit for my soul. Remember how I stood before you to speak good for them, to turn away your wrath from them. ²¹Therefore deliver up their children to the famine, and give them over to the power of the sword. Let their wives become childless and widows. Let their men be killed and their young men struck by the sword in battle. ²²Let a cry be heard from their houses when you bring a troop suddenly on them; for they have dug a pit to take me and hidden snares for my feet. ²³Yet, LORD, you know all their counsel against me to kill me. Don’t forgive their iniquity. Don’t blot out their sin from your sight, Let them be overthrown before you. Deal with them in the time of

your anger.

19 Thus said the LORD, “Go, and buy a potter’s earthen container, and take some of the elders of the people and of the elders of the priests; ²and go out to the valley of the son of Hinnom, which is by the entry of the gate Harsith, and proclaim there the words that I will tell you. ³Say, ‘Hear the LORD’s word, kings of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem: The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says, “Behold, I will bring evil on this place, which whoever hears, his ears will tingle. ⁴Because they have forsaken me, and have defiled this place, and have burned incense in it to other gods that they didn’t know—they, their fathers, and the kings of Judah—and have filled this place with the blood of innocents, ⁵and have built the high places of Baal to burn their children in the fire for burnt offerings to Baal, which I didn’t command, nor speak, which didn’t even enter into my mind. ⁶Therefore, behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that this place will no more be called ‘Topheth’, nor ‘The Valley of the son of Hinnom’, but ‘The valley of Slaughter’. ⁷““I will make the counsel of Judah and Jerusalem void in this place. I will cause them to fall by the sword before their enemies, and by the hand of those who seek their life. I will give their dead bodies to be food for the birds of the sky and for the animals of the earth. ⁸I will make this city an astonishment and a hissing. Everyone who passes by it will be astonished and hiss because of all its plagues. ⁹I will cause them to eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters. They will each eat the flesh of his friend in the siege and in the distress with which their enemies, and those who seek their life, will distress them.”’ ¹⁰“Then you shall break the container in the sight of the men who go with you, ¹¹and shall tell them, ‘The LORD of Hosts says: “Even so I will break this people and this city as one breaks a potter’s vessel, that can’t be made whole again. They will bury in Topheth until there is no place to bury. ¹²This is what I will do to this place,” says the LORD, “and to its inhabitants, even making this city as Topheth. ¹³The houses of Jerusalem and the houses of the kings of Judah, which are defiled, will be as the place of Topheth, even all the houses on whose roofs they have burned incense to all the army of the sky and have poured out drink offerings to other gods.”’” ¹⁴Then Jeremiah came from Topheth, where the LORD had sent him to prophesy, and he stood in the court of the LORD’s house, and said to all the people: ¹⁵“The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says, ‘Behold, I will bring on this city and on all its towns all the evil that I have pronounced against it, because they have made their neck stiff, that they may not hear my words.’”

20 Now Pashhur, the son of Immer the priest, who was chief officer in the LORD’s house, heard Jeremiah prophesying these things. ²Then Pashhur struck Jeremiah the

prophet and put him in the stocks that were in the upper gate of Benjamin, which was in the LORD’s house. ³On the next day, Pashhur released Jeremiah out of the stocks. Then Jeremiah said to him, “The LORD has not called your name Pashhur, but Magormissabib. ^{vii} ⁴For the LORD says, ‘Behold, I will make you a terror to yourself and to all your friends. They will fall by the sword of their enemies, and your eyes will see it. I will give all Judah into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will carry them captive to Babylon, and will kill them with the sword. ⁵Moreover I will give all the riches of this city, and all its gains, and all its precious things, yes, I will give all the treasures of the kings of Judah into the hand of their enemies. They will make them captives, take them, and carry them to Babylon. ⁶You, Pashhur, and all who dwell in your house will go into captivity. You will come to Babylon, and there you will die, and there you will be buried, you, and all your friends, to whom you have prophesied falsely.”’ ⁷LORD, you have persuaded me, and I was persuaded. You are stronger than I, and have prevailed. I have become a laughingstock all day. Everyone mocks me. ⁸For as often as I speak, I cry out; I cry, “Violence and destruction!” because the LORD’s word has been made a reproach to me, and a derision, all day. ⁹If I say that I will not make mention of him, or speak any more in his name, then there is in my heart as it were a burning fire shut up in my bones. I am weary with holding it in. I can’t. ¹⁰For I have heard the defaming of many: “Terror on every side! Denounce, and we will denounce him!” say all my familiar friends, those who watch for my fall. “Perhaps he will be persuaded, and we will prevail against him, and we will take our revenge on him.” ¹¹But the LORD is with me as an awesome mighty one. Therefore my persecutors will stumble, and they won’t prevail. They will be utterly disappointed because they have not dealt wisely, even with an everlasting dishonor which will never be forgotten. ¹²But the LORD of Hosts, who tests the righteous, who sees the heart and the mind, let me see your vengeance on them, for I have revealed my cause to you. ¹³Sing to the LORD! Praise the LORD, for he has delivered the soul of the needy from the hand of evildoers. ¹⁴Cursed is the day in which I was born. Don’t let the day in which my mother bore me be blessed. ¹⁵Cursed is the man who brought news to my father, saying, “A boy is born to you,” making him very glad. ¹⁶Let that man be as the cities which the LORD overthrew, and didn’t repent. Let him hear a cry in the morning, and shouting at noontime, ¹⁷because he didn’t kill me from the womb. So my mother would have been my grave, and her womb always great. ¹⁸Why did I come out of the womb to see labor and sorrow, that my days should be consumed with shame?

21 The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD,

^{vii}“Magormissabib” means “surrounded by terror”

when King Zedekiah sent to him Pashhur the son of Malchijah, and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, saying, ²“Please inquire of the LORD for us; for Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon makes war against us. Perhaps the LORD will deal with us according to all his wondrous works, that he may withdraw from us.” ³Then Jeremiah said to them, “Tell Zedekiah: ⁴‘The LORD, the God of Israel says, “Behold, I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands, with which you fight against the king of Babylon, and against the Kasdim who besiege you outside the walls; and I will gather them into the middle of this city. ⁵I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, in wrath, and in great indignation. ⁶I will strike the inhabitants of this city, both man and animal. They will die of a great pestilence. ⁷Afterward,” says the LORD, “I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah, his servants, and the people, even those who are left in this city from the pestilence, from the sword, and from the famine, into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of their enemies, and into the hand of those who seek their life. He will strike them with the edge of the sword. He will not spare them, have pity, or have mercy.” ⁸“You shall say to this people, ‘The LORD says: “Behold, I set before you the way of life and the way of death. ⁹He who remains in this city will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, but he who goes out and passes over to the Kasdim who besiege you, he will live, and he will escape with his life. ¹⁰For I have set my face on this city for evil, and not for good,” says the LORD. “It will be given into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will burn it with fire.” ¹¹“Concerning the house of the king of Judah, hear the LORD’s word: ¹²House of David, the LORD says, ‘Execute justice in the morning, and deliver him who is robbed out of the hand of the oppressor, lest my wrath go out like fire, and burn so that no one can quench it, because of the evil of your doings. ¹³Behold, I am against you, O inhabitant of the valley, and of the rock of the plain,’ says the LORD. ‘You that say, “Who would come down against us?” or, “Who would enter into our homes?” ¹⁴I will punish you according to the fruit of your doings, says the LORD; and I will kindle a fire in her forest, and it will devour all that is around her.’”

²²The LORD said, “Go down to the house of the king of Judah, and speak this word there: ²‘Hear the LORD’s word, king of Judah, who sits on David’s throne—you, your servants, and your people who enter in by these gates. ³The LORD says: “Execute justice and righteousness, and deliver him who is robbed out of the hand of the oppressor. Do no wrong. Do no violence to the foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow. Don’t shed innocent blood in this place. ⁴For if you do this thing indeed, then kings sitting on David’s throne will enter in by the gates of this house,

riding in chariots and on horses—they, their servants, and their people. ⁵But if you will not hear these words, I swear by myself,” says the LORD, “that this house will become a desolation.”” ⁶For the LORD says concerning the house of the king of Judah: “You are Gilead to me, the head of Lebanon. Yet surely I will make you a wilderness, cities which are not inhabited. ⁷I will prepare destroyers against you, everyone with his weapons, and they will cut down your choice cedars, and cast them into the fire. ⁸“Many nations will pass by this city, and they will each ask his neighbor, ‘Why has the LORD done this to this great city?’ ⁹Then they will answer, ‘Because they abandoned the covenant of the LORD their God, worshiped other gods, and served them.’” ¹⁰Don’t weep for the dead. Don’t bemoan him; but weep bitterly for him who goes away, for he will return no more, and not see his native country. ¹¹For the LORD says touching Shallum the son of Josiah, king of Judah, who reigned instead of Josiah his father, and who went out of this place: “He won’t return there any more. ¹²But he will die in the place where they have led him captive. He will see this land no more.” ¹³“Woe to him who builds his house by unrighteousness, and his rooms by injustice; who uses his neighbor’s service without wages, and doesn’t give him his hire; ¹⁴who says, ‘I will build myself a wide house and spacious rooms,’ and cuts out windows for himself, with a cedar ceiling, and painted with red. ¹⁵“Should you reign because you strive to excel in cedar? Didn’t your father eat and drink, and do justice and righteousness? Then it was well with him. ¹⁶He judged the cause of the poor and needy; so then it was well. Wasn’t this to know me?” says the LORD. ¹⁷But your eyes and your heart are only for your covetousness, for shedding innocent blood, for oppression, and for doing violence.” ¹⁸Therefore the LORD says concerning Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah: “They won’t lament for him, saying, ‘Ah my brother!’ or, ‘Ah sister!’ They won’t lament for him, saying ‘Ah lord!’ or, ‘Ah his glory!’ ¹⁹He will be buried with the burial of a donkey, drawn and cast out beyond the gates of Jerusalem.” ²⁰“Go up to Lebanon, and cry out. Lift up your voice in Bashan, and cry from Abarim; for all your lovers have been destroyed. ²¹I spoke to you in your prosperity, but you said, ‘I will not listen.’ This has been your way from your youth, that you didn’t obey my voice. ²²The wind will feed all your shepherds, and your lovers will go into captivity. Surely then you will be ashamed and confounded for all your wickedness. ²³Inhabitant of Lebanon, who makes your nest in the cedars, how greatly to be pitied you will be when pangs come on you, the pain as of a woman in travail! ²⁴“As I live,” says the LORD, “though Coniah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah were the signet on my right hand, I would still pluck you from there. ²⁵I would give you into the hand of those who seek your life, and into the hand of them of whom you are afraid, even into the hand of

Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of the Kasdim. ²⁶I will cast you out with your mother who bore you into another country, where you were not born; and there you will die. ²⁷But to the land to which their soul longs to return, there they will not return.” ²⁸Is this man Coniah a despised broken vessel? Is he a vessel in which no one delights? Why are they cast out, he and his offspring, and cast into a land which they don’t know? ²⁹O earth, earth, hear the LORD’s word! ³⁰The LORD says, “Record this man as childless, a man who will not prosper in his days; for no more will a man of his offspring prosper, sitting on David’s throne and ruling in Judah.”

23“Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture!” says the LORD. ²Therefore the LORD, the God of Israel, says against the shepherds who feed my people: “You have scattered my flock, driven them away, and have not visited them. Behold, I will visit on you the evil of your doings,” says the LORD. ³“I will gather the remnant of my flock out of all the countries where I have driven them, and will bring them again to their folds; and they will be fruitful and multiply. ⁴I will set up shepherds over them who will feed them. They will no longer be afraid or dismayed, neither will any be lacking,” says the LORD. ⁵“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will raise to David a righteous Branch; and he will reign as king and deal wisely, and will execute justice and righteousness in the land. ⁶In his days Judah will be saved, and Israel will dwell safely. This is his name by which he will be called: The LORD our righteousness. ⁷“Therefore, behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that they will no more say, ‘As the LORD lives, who brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;’ ⁸but, ‘As the LORD lives, who brought up and who led the offspring of the house of Israel out of the north country, and from all the countries where I had driven them.’ Then they will dwell in their own land.” ⁹Concerning the prophets: My heart within me is broken. All my bones shake. I am like a drunken man, and like a man whom wine has overcome, because of the LORD, and because of his holy words. ¹⁰“For the land is full of adulterers; for because of the curse the land mourns. The pastures of the wilderness have dried up. Their course is evil, and their might is not right; ¹¹for both prophet and priest are profane. Yes, in my house I have found their wickedness,” says the LORD. ¹²Therefore their way will be to them as slippery places in the darkness. They will be driven on, and fall therein; for I will bring evil on them, even the year of their visitation,” says the LORD. ¹³“I have seen folly in the prophets of Samaria. They prophesied by Baal, and caused my people Israel to err. ¹⁴In the prophets of Jerusalem I have also seen a horrible thing: they commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one returns from his wickedness. They have all become to me

as Sodom, and its inhabitants as Gomorrah.” ¹⁵Therefore the LORD of Hosts says concerning the prophets: “Behold, I will feed them with wormwood, and make them drink poisoned water; for from the prophets of Jerusalem ungodliness has gone out into all the land.” ¹⁶The LORD of Hosts says, “Don’t listen to the words of the prophets who prophesy to you. They teach you vanity. They speak a vision of their own heart, and not out of the mouth of the LORD. ¹⁷They say continually to those who despise me, ‘The LORD has said, “You will have peace;”’ and to everyone who walks in the stubbornness of his own heart they say, ‘No evil will come on you.’ ¹⁸For who has stood in the council of the LORD, that he should perceive and hear his word? Who has listened to my word, and heard it? ¹⁹Behold, the LORD’s storm, his wrath, has gone out. Yes, a whirling storm! It will burst on the head of the wicked. ²⁰The LORD’s anger will not return until he has executed and performed the intents of his heart. In the latter days, you will understand it perfectly. ²¹I didn’t send these prophets, yet they ran. I didn’t speak to them, yet they prophesied. ²²But if they had stood in my council, then they would have caused my people to hear my words, and would have turned them from their evil way, and from the evil of their doings. ²³“Am I a God at hand,” says the LORD, “and not a God afar off? ²⁴Can anyone hide himself in secret places so that I can’t see him?” says the LORD. “Don’t I fill heaven and earth?” says the LORD. ²⁵“I have heard what the prophets have said, who prophesy lies in my name, saying, ‘I had a dream! I had a dream!’ ²⁶How long will this be in the heart of the prophets who prophesy lies, even the prophets of the deceit of their own heart? ²⁷They intend to cause my people to forget my name by their dreams which they each tell his neighbor, as their fathers forgot my name because of Baal. ²⁸The prophet who has a dream, let him tell a dream; and he who has my word, let him speak my word faithfully. What is the straw to the wheat?” says the LORD. ²⁹“Isn’t my word like fire?” says the LORD; “and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces? ³⁰“Therefore behold, I am against the prophets,” says the LORD, “who each steal my words from his neighbor. ³¹Behold, I am against the prophets,” says the LORD, “who use their tongues, and say, ‘He says.’ ³²Behold, I am against those who prophesy lying dreams,” says the LORD, “who tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies, and by their vain boasting; yet I didn’t send them or command them. They don’t profit this people at all,” says the LORD. ³³“When this people, or the prophet, or a priest, asks you, saying, ‘What is the message from the LORD?’ Then you shall tell them, “‘What message? I will cast you off,’” says the LORD.’ ³⁴As for the prophet, the priest, and the people, who say, ‘The message from the LORD,’ I will even punish that man and his household. ³⁵You will say everyone to his neighbor, and everyone to his brother, ‘What has the LORD answered?’ and, ‘What

has the LORD said?" ³⁶You will mention the message from the LORD no more, for every man's own word has become his message; for you have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of Hosts, our God. ³⁷You will say to the prophet, 'What has the LORD answered you?' and, 'What has the LORD spoken?' ³⁸Although you say, 'The message from the LORD,' therefore the LORD says: 'Because you say this word, "The message from the LORD," and I have sent to you, telling you not to say, "The message from the LORD,"' ³⁹therefore behold, I will utterly forget you, and I will cast you off with the city that I gave to you and to your fathers, away from my presence. ⁴⁰I will bring an everlasting reproach on you, and a perpetual shame, which will not be forgotten.'

24The LORD showed me, and behold, two baskets of figs were set before the LORD's temple, after Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, and the princes of Judah, with the craftsmen and smiths, from Jerusalem, and had brought them to Babylon. ²One basket had very good figs, like the figs that are first-ripe; and the other basket had very bad figs, which could not be eaten, they were so bad. ³Then the LORD asked me, "What do you see, Jeremiah?" I said, "Figs. The good figs are very good, and the bad are very bad, so bad that they can't be eaten." ⁴The LORD's word came to me, saying, ⁵"The LORD, the God of Israel says: 'Like these good figs, so I will regard the captives of Judah, whom I have sent out of this place into the land of the Kasdim, as good. ⁶For I will set my eyes on them for good, and I will bring them again to this land. I will build them, and not pull them down. I will plant them, and not pluck them up. ⁷I will give them a heart to know me, that I am the LORD. They will be my people, and I will be their God; for they will return to me with their whole heart. ⁸"'As the bad figs, which can't be eaten, they are so bad,' surely the LORD says, 'So I will give up Zedekiah the king of Judah, and his princes, and the remnant of Jerusalem who remain in this land, and those who dwell in the land of Egypt. ⁹I will even give them up to be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth for evil, to be a reproach and a proverb, a taunt and a curse, in all places where I will drive them. ¹⁰I will send the sword, the famine, and the pestilence among them, until they are consumed from off the land that I gave to them and to their fathers.'

25The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah (this was the first year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon), ²which Jeremiah the prophet spoke to all the people of Judah, and to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem: ³From the thirteenth year of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah, even to this day, these

twenty-three years, the LORD's word has come to me, and I have spoken to you, rising up early and speaking; but you have not listened. ⁴The LORD has sent to you all his servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them (but you have not listened or inclined your ear to hear), ⁵saying, "Return now everyone from his evil way, and from the evil of your doings, and dwell in the land that the LORD has given to you and to your fathers, from of old and even forever more. ⁶Don't go after other gods to serve them or worship them, and don't provoke me to anger with the work of your hands; then I will do you no harm." ⁷"Yet you have not listened to me," says the LORD, "that you may provoke me to anger with the work of your hands to your own hurt." ⁸Therefore the LORD of Hosts says: "Because you have not heard my words, ⁹behold, I will send and take all the families of the north," says the LORD, "and I will send to Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will bring them against this land, and against its inhabitants, and against all these nations around. I will utterly destroy them, and make them an astonishment, and a hissing, and perpetual desolations. ¹⁰Moreover I will take from them the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the sound of the millstones, and the light of the lamp. ¹¹This whole land will be a desolation, and an astonishment; and these nations will serve the king of Babylon seventy years. ¹²"It will happen, when seventy years are accomplished, that I will punish the king of Babylon and that nation," says the LORD, "for their iniquity. I will make the land of the Kasdim desolate forever. ¹³I will bring on that land all my words which I have pronounced against it, even all that is written in this book, which Jeremiah has prophesied against all the nations. ¹⁴For many nations and great kings will make bondservants of them, even of them. I will recompense them according to their deeds, and according to the work of their hands." ¹⁵For the LORD, the God of Israel, says to me: "Take this cup of the wine of wrath from my hand, and cause all the nations to whom I send you to drink it. ¹⁶They will drink, and reel back and forth, and be insane, because of the sword that I will send among them." ¹⁷Then I took the cup at the LORD's hand, and made all the nations to drink, to whom the LORD had sent me: ¹⁸Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah, with its kings and its princes, to make them a desolation, an astonishment, a hissing, and a curse, as it is today; ¹⁹Pharaoh king of Egypt, with his servants, his princes, and all his people; ²⁰and all the mixed people, and all the kings of the land of Uz, all the kings of the Philistines, Ashkelon, Gaza, Ekron, and the remnant of Ashdod; ²¹Edom, Moab, and the children of Ammon; ²²and all the kings of Tyre, all the kings of Sidon, and the kings of the isle which is beyond the sea; ²³Dedan, Tema, Buz, and all who have the corners of their beard cut off; ²⁴and all the kings of Arabia, all the kings of the mixed people who dwell in the

wilderness; ²⁵and all the kings of Zimri, all the kings of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes; ²⁶and all the kings of the north, far and near, one with another; and all the kingdoms of the world, which are on the surface of the earth. The king of Sheshach will drink after them. ²⁷"You shall tell them, 'The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: "Drink, and be drunk, vomit, fall, and rise no more, because of the sword which I will send among you."' ²⁸It shall be, if they refuse to take the cup at your hand to drink, then you shall tell them, 'The LORD of Hosts says: "You shall surely drink. ²⁹For, behold, I begin to work evil at the city which is called by my name; and should you be utterly unpunished? You will not be unpunished; for I will call for a sword on all the inhabitants of the earth, says the LORD of Hosts."' ³⁰"Therefore prophesy against them all these words, and tell them, "'The LORD will roar from on high, and utter his voice from his holy habitation. He will mightily roar against his fold. He will give a shout, as those who tread grapes, against all the inhabitants of the earth. ³¹A noise will come even to the end of the earth; for the LORD has a controversy with the nations. He will enter into judgment with all flesh. As for the wicked, he will give them to the sword,"' says the LORD." ³²The LORD of Hosts says, "Behold, evil will go out from nation to nation, and a great storm will be raised up from the uttermost parts of the earth." ³³The slain of the LORD will be at that day from one end of the earth even to the other end of the earth. They won't be lamented. They won't be gathered or buried. They will be dung on the surface of the ground. ³⁴Wail, you shepherds, and cry. Wallow in dust, you leader of the flock; for the days of your slaughter and of your dispersions have fully come, and you will fall like fine pottery. ³⁵The shepherds will have no way to flee. The leader of the flock will have no escape. ³⁶A voice of the cry of the shepherds, and the wailing of the leader of the flock, for the LORD destroys their pasture. ³⁷The peaceful folds are brought to silence because of the fierce anger of the LORD. ³⁸He has left his covert, as the lion; for their land has become an astonishment because of the fierceness of the oppression, and because of his fierce anger.

26In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came from the LORD: ²"The LORD says: 'Stand in the court of the LORD's house, and speak to all the cities of Judah which come to worship in the LORD's house, all the words that I command you to speak to them. Don't omit a word. ³It may be they will listen, and every man turn from his evil way, that I may relent from the evil which I intend to do to them because of the evil of their doings.' ⁴You shall tell them, "The LORD says: 'If you will not listen to me, to walk in my law which I have set before you, ⁵to listen to the words of my servants the prophets whom I send to

you, even rising up early and sending them—but you have not listened— ⁶then I will make this house like Shiloh, and will make this city a curse to all the nations of the earth.'"

⁷The priests and the prophets and all the people heard Jeremiah speaking these words in the LORD's house. ⁸When Jeremiah had finished speaking all that the LORD had commanded him to speak to all the people, the priests and the prophets and all the people seized him, saying, "You shall surely die! ⁹Why have you prophesied in the LORD's name, saying, 'This house will be like Shiloh, and this city will be desolate, without inhabitant?'" All the people were crowded around Jeremiah in the LORD's house. ¹⁰When the princes of Judah heard these things, they came up from the king's house to the LORD's house; and they sat in the entry of the new gate of the LORD's house. ¹¹Then the priests and the prophets spoke to the princes and to all the people, saying, "This man is worthy of death, for he has prophesied against this city, as you have heard with your ears." ¹²Then Jeremiah spoke to all the princes and to all the people, saying, "The LORD sent me to prophesy against this house and against this city all the words that you have heard. ¹³Now therefore amend your ways and your doings, and obey the LORD your God's voice; then the LORD will relent from the evil that he has pronounced against you. ¹⁴But as for me, behold, I am in your hand. Do with me what is good and right in your eyes. ¹⁵Only know for certain that if you put me to death, you will bring innocent blood on yourselves, on this city, and on its inhabitants; for in truth the LORD has sent me to you to speak all these words in your ears." ¹⁶Then the princes and all the people said to the priests and to the prophets: "This man is not worthy of death; for he has spoken to us in the name of the LORD our God." ¹⁷Then certain of the elders of the land rose up, and spoke to all the assembly of the people, saying, ¹⁸"Micah the Morashtite prophesied in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah; and he spoke to all the people of Judah, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts says: "'Zion will be plowed as a field, and Jerusalem will become heaps, and the mountain of the house as the high places of a forest.' ¹⁹Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all Judah put him to death? Didn't he fear the LORD, and entreat the favor of the LORD, and the LORD relented of the disaster which he had pronounced against them? We would commit great evil against our own souls that way!" ²⁰There was also a man who prophesied in the LORD's name, Uriah the son of Shemaiah of Kiriath Jearim; and he prophesied against this city and against this land according to all the words of Jeremiah. ²¹When Jehoiakim the king, with all his mighty men and all the princes heard his words, the king sought to put him to death; but when Uriah heard it, he was afraid, and fled, and went into Egypt. ²²Then Jehoiakim the king sent Elnathan the son of Achbor and certain men with him into Egypt. ²³They fetched Uriah out of Egypt

and brought him to Jehoiakim the king, who killed him with the sword and cast his dead body into the graves of the common people. ²⁴But the hand of Ahikam the son of Shaphan was with Jeremiah, so that they didn't give him into the hand of the people to put him to death.

27In the beginning of the reign of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²the LORD says to me: "Make bonds and bars, and put them on your neck. ³Then send them to the king of Edom, to the king of Moab, to the king of the children of Ammon, to the king of Tyre, and to the king of Sidon, by the hand of the messengers who come to Jerusalem to Zedekiah king of Judah. ⁴Give them a command to their masters, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says, "You shall tell your masters: ⁵'I have made the earth, the men, and the animals that are on the surface of the earth by my great power and by my outstretched arm. I give it to whom it seems right to me. ⁶Now I have given all these lands into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant. I have also given the animals of the field to him to serve him. ⁷All the nations will serve him, his son, and his son's son, until the time of his own land comes. Then many nations and great kings will make him their bondservant. ⁸"'" "It will happen that I will punish the nation and the kingdom which will not serve the same Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and that will not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon,' says the LORD, 'with the sword, with famine, and with pestilence, until I have consumed them by his hand. ⁹But as for you, don't listen to your prophets, to your diviners, to your dreams, to your soothsayers, or to your sorcerers, who speak to you, saying, "You shall not serve the king of Babylon;" ¹⁰for they prophesy a lie to you, to remove you far from your land, so that I would drive you out, and you would perish. ¹¹But the nation that brings their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon and serves him, that nation I will let remain in their own land,' says the LORD; 'and they will till it and dwell in it.''" ¹²I spoke to Zedekiah king of Judah according to all these words, saying, "Bring your necks under the yoke of the king of Babylon, and serve him and his people, and live. ¹³Why will you die, you and your people, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, as the LORD has spoken concerning the nation that will not serve the king of Babylon? ¹⁴Don't listen to the words of the prophets who speak to you, saying, 'You shall not serve the king of Babylon;' for they prophesy a lie to you. ¹⁵For I have not sent them," says the LORD, "but they prophesy falsely in my name; that I may drive you out, and that you may perish, you, and the prophets who prophesy to you." ¹⁶Also I spoke to the priests and to all this people, saying, the LORD says, "Don't listen to the words of your prophets who prophesy to you, saying, 'Behold, the vessels

of the LORD's house will now shortly be brought again from Babylon;' for they prophesy a lie to you. ¹⁷Don't listen to them. Serve the king of Babylon, and live. Why should this city become a desolation? ¹⁸But if they are prophets, and if the LORD's word is with them, let them now make intercession to the LORD of Hosts, that the vessels which are left in the LORD's house, in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem, don't go to Babylon. ¹⁹For the LORD of Hosts says concerning the pillars, concerning the sea, concerning the bases, and concerning the rest of the vessels that are left in this city, ²⁰which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon didn't take when he carried away captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, from Jerusalem to Babylon, and all the nobles of Judah and Jerusalem— ²¹yes, the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says concerning the vessels that are left in the LORD's house, and in the house of the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem: ²²'They will be carried to Babylon, and there they will be, until the day that I visit them,' says the LORD; 'then I will bring them up, and restore them to this place.'"

28That same year, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the fourth year, in the fifth month, Hananiah the son of Azzur, the prophet, who was of Gibeon, spoke to me in the LORD's house, in the presence of the priests and of all the people, saying, ²"The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says, 'I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon. ³Within two full years I will bring again into this place all the vessels of the LORD's house that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took away from this place and carried to Babylon. ⁴I will bring again to this place Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, with all the captives of Judah, who went to Babylon,' says the LORD; 'for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.'" ⁵Then the prophet Jeremiah said to the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests, and in the presence of all the people who stood in the LORD's house, ⁶even the prophet Jeremiah said, "Amen! May the LORD do so. May the LORD perform your words which you have prophesied, to bring again the vessels of the LORD's house, and all those who are captives, from Babylon to this place. ⁷Nevertheless listen now to this word that I speak in your ears, and in the ears of all the people: ⁸The prophets who have been before me and before you of old prophesied against many countries, and against great kingdoms, of war, of evil, and of pestilence. ⁹As for prophet who prophesies of peace, when the word of the prophet happens, then the prophet will be known, that the LORD has truly sent him." ¹⁰Then Hananiah the prophet took the bar from off the prophet Jeremiah's neck, and broke it. ¹¹Hananiah spoke in the presence of all the people, saying, "The LORD says: 'Even so I will break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from off the neck of all the

nations within two full years.” Then the prophet Jeremiah went his way. ¹²Then the LORD’s word came to Jeremiah, after Hananiah the prophet had broken the bar from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying, ¹³“Go, and tell Hananiah, saying, ‘The LORD says, “You have broken the bars of wood, but you have made in their place bars of iron.”’ ¹⁴For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says, “I have put a yoke of iron on the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and they will serve him. I have also given him the animals of the field.”’” ¹⁵Then the prophet Jeremiah said to Hananiah the prophet, “Listen, Hananiah! The LORD has not sent you, but you make this people trust in a lie. ¹⁶Therefore the LORD says, ‘Behold, I will send you away from off the surface of the earth. This year you will die, because you have spoken rebellion against the LORD.’” ¹⁷So Hananiah the prophet died the same year in the seventh month.

29Now these are the words of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem to the residue of the elders of the captivity, and to the priests, to the prophets, and to all the people whom Nebuchadnezzar had carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon, ²(after Jeconiah the king, the queen mother, the eunuchs, the princes of Judah and Jerusalem, the craftsmen, and the smiths had departed from Jerusalem), ³by the hand of Elasah the son of Shaphan and Gemariah the son of Hilkiah, (whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent to Babylon to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon). It said: ⁴The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says to all the captives whom I have caused to be carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon: ⁵“Build houses and dwell in them. Plant gardens and eat their fruit. ⁶Take wives and father sons and daughters. Take wives for your sons, and give your daughters to husbands, that they may bear sons and daughters. Multiply there, and don’t be diminished. ⁷Seek the peace of the city where I have caused you to be carried away captive, and pray to the LORD for it; for in its peace you will have peace.” ⁸For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: “Don’t let your prophets who are among you and your diviners deceive you. Don’t listen to your dreams which you cause to be dreamed. ⁹For they prophesy falsely to you in my name. I have not sent them,” says the LORD. ¹⁰For the LORD says, “After seventy years are accomplished for Babylon, I will visit you and perform my good word toward you, in causing you to return to this place. ¹¹For I know the thoughts that I think toward you,” says the LORD, “thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you hope and a future. ¹²You shall call on me, and you shall go and pray to me, and I will listen to you. ¹³You shall seek me and find me, when you search for me with all your heart. ¹⁴I will be found by you,” says the LORD, “and I will turn again your captivity, and I will gather you from all the nations, and from all the places where I have driven you,

says the LORD. I will bring you again to the place from where I caused you to be carried away captive.” ¹⁵Because you have said, “The LORD has raised us up prophets in Babylon,” ¹⁶the LORD says concerning the king who sits on David’s throne, and concerning all the people who dwell in this city, your brothers who haven’t gone with you into captivity, ¹⁷the LORD of Hosts says: “Behold, I will send on them the sword, the famine, and the pestilence, and will make them like rotten figs that can’t be eaten, they are so bad. ¹⁸I will pursue after them with the sword, with the famine, and with the pestilence, and will deliver them to be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth, to be an object of horror, an astonishment, a hissing, and a reproach among all the nations where I have driven them, ¹⁹because they have not listened to my words,” says the LORD, “with which I sent to them my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them; but you would not hear,” says the LORD. ²⁰Hear therefore the LORD’s word, all you captives whom I have sent away from Jerusalem to Babylon. ²¹The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says concerning Ahab the son of Kolaiah, and concerning Zedekiah the son of Maaseiah, who prophesy a lie to you in my name: “Behold, I will deliver them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and he will kill them before your eyes. ²²A curse will be taken up about them by all the captives of Judah who are in Babylon, saying, ‘The LORD make you like Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in the fire;’ ²³because they have done foolish things in Israel, and have committed adultery with their neighbors’ wives, and have spoken words in my name falsely, which I didn’t command them. I am he who knows, and am witness,” says the LORD. ²⁴Concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite you shall speak, saying, ²⁵“The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says, ‘Because you have sent letters in your own name to all the people who are at Jerusalem, and to Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, and to all the priests, saying, ²⁶“The LORD has made you priest in the place of Jehoiada the priest, that there may be officers in the LORD’s house, for every man who is crazy and makes himself a prophet, that you should put him in the stocks and in shackles. ²⁷Now therefore, why have you not rebuked Jeremiah of Anathoth, who makes himself a prophet to you, ²⁸because he has sent to us in Babylon, saying, The captivity is long. Build houses, and dwell in them. Plant gardens, and eat their fruit?’”’” ²⁹Zephaniah the priest read this letter in the hearing of Jeremiah the prophet. ³⁰Then the LORD’s word came to Jeremiah, saying, ³¹“Send to all of the captives, saying, ‘The LORD says concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite: “Because Shemaiah has prophesied to you, and I didn’t send him, and he has caused you to trust in a lie,” ³²therefore the LORD says, “Behold, I will punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite and his offspring. He will not have a man to dwell among this people. He won’t see the

good that I will do to my people,” says the LORD, “because he has spoken rebellion against the LORD.””

30The word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²“The LORD, the God of Israel, says, ‘Write all the words that I have spoken to you in a book. ³For, behold, the days come,’ says the LORD, ‘that I will reverse the captivity of my people Israel and Judah,’ says the LORD. ‘I will cause them to return to the land that I gave to their fathers, and they will possess it.’” ⁴These are the words that the LORD spoke concerning Israel and concerning Judah. ⁵For the LORD says: “We have heard a voice of trembling; a voice of fear, and not of peace. ⁶Ask now, and see whether a man travails with child. Why do I see every man with his hands on his waist, as a woman in travail, and all faces are turned pale? ⁷Alas, for that day is great, so that none is like it! It is even the time of Jacob’s trouble; but he will be saved out of it. ⁸It will come to pass in that day, says the LORD of Hosts, that I will break his yoke from off your neck, and will burst your bonds. Strangers will no more make them their bondservants; ⁹but they will serve the LORD their God, and David their king, whom I will raise up to them. ¹⁰Therefore don’t be afraid, O Jacob my servant, says the LORD. Don’t be dismayed, Israel. For, behold, I will save you from afar, and save your offspring from the land of their captivity. Jacob will return, and will be quiet and at ease. No one will make him afraid. ¹¹For I am with you, says the LORD, to save you; for I will make a full end of all the nations where I have scattered you, but I will not make a full end of you; but I will correct you in measure, and will in no way leave you unpunished.” ¹²For the LORD says, “Your hurt is incurable. Your wound is grievous. ¹³There is no one to plead your cause, that you may be bound up. You have no healing medicines. ¹⁴All your lovers have forgotten you. They don’t seek you. For I have wounded you with the wound of an enemy, with the chastisement of a cruel one, for the greatness of your iniquity, because your sins were increased. ¹⁵Why do you cry over your injury? Your pain is incurable. For the greatness of your iniquity, because your sins have increased, I have done these things to you. ¹⁶Therefore all those who devour you will be devoured. All your adversaries, everyone of them, will go into captivity. Those who plunder you will be plunder. I will make all who prey on you become prey. ¹⁷For I will restore health to you, and I will heal you of your wounds,” says the LORD, “because they have called you an outcast, saying, ‘It is Zion, whom no man seeks after.’” ¹⁸The LORD says: “Behold, I will reverse the captivity of Jacob’s tents, and have compassion on his dwelling places. The city will be built on its own hill, and the palace will be inhabited in its own place. ¹⁹Thanksgiving will proceed out of them with the voice of those who make merry. I will multiply them, and they will not be few; I will also glorify them, and they

will not be small. ²⁰Their children also will be as before, and their congregation will be established before me. I will punish all who oppress them. ²¹Their prince will be one of them, and their ruler will proceed from among them. I will cause him to draw near, and he will approach me; for who is he who has had boldness to approach me?” says the LORD. ²²“You shall be my people, and I will be your God. ²³Behold, the LORD’s storm, his wrath, has gone out, a sweeping storm; it will burst on the head of the wicked. ²⁴The fierce anger of the LORD will not return until he has accomplished, and until he has performed the intentions of his heart. In the latter days you will understand it.”

31“At that time,” says the LORD, “I will be the God of all the families of Israel, and they will be my people.” ²The LORD says, “The people who survive the sword found favor in the wilderness; even Israel, when I went to cause him to rest.” ³The LORD appeared of old to me, saying, “Yes, I have loved you with an everlasting love. Therefore I have drawn you with loving kindness. ⁴I will build you again, and you will be built, O virgin of Israel. You will again be adorned with your tambourines, and will go out in the dances of those who make merry. ⁵Again you will plant vineyards on the mountains of Samaria. The planters will plant, and will enjoy its fruit. ⁶For there will be a day that the watchmen on the hills of Ephraim cry, ‘Arise! Let’s go up to Zion to the LORD our God.’” ⁷For the LORD says, “Sing with gladness for Jacob, and shout for the chief of the nations. Publish, praise, and say, ‘The LORD, save your people, the remnant of Israel!’” ⁸Behold, I will bring them from the north country, and gather them from the uttermost parts of the earth, along with the blind and the lame, the woman with child and her who travails with child together. They will return as a great company. ⁹They will come with weeping. I will lead them with petitions. I will cause them to walk by rivers of waters, in a straight way in which they won’t stumble; for I am a father to Israel. Ephraim is my firstborn. ¹⁰“Hear the LORD’s word, you nations, and declare it in the distant islands. Say, ‘He who scattered Israel will gather him, and keep him, as a shepherd does his flock.’” ¹¹For the LORD has ransomed Jacob, and redeemed him from the hand of him who was stronger than he. ¹²They will come and sing in the height of Zion, and will flow to the goodness of the LORD, to the grain, to the new wine, to the oil, and to the young of the flock and of the herd. Their soul will be as a watered garden. They will not sorrow any more at all. ¹³Then the virgin will rejoice in the dance, the young men and the old together; for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow. ¹⁴I will satiate the soul of the priests with fatness, and my people will be satisfied with my goodness,” says the LORD. ¹⁵The LORD says: “A voice is heard in Ramah, lamenta-

tion and bitter weeping, Rachel weeping for her children. She refuses to be comforted for her children, because they are no more.” ¹⁶The LORD says: “Refrain your voice from weeping, and your eyes from tears, for your work will be rewarded,” says the LORD. “They will come again from the land of the enemy. ¹⁷There is hope for your latter end,” says the LORD. “Your children will come again to their own territory. ¹⁸“I have surely heard Ephraim grieving thus, ‘You have chastised me, and I was chastised, as an untrained calf. Turn me, and I will be turned, for you are the LORD my God. ¹⁹Surely after that I was turned. I repented. After that I was instructed. I struck my thigh. I was ashamed, yes, even confounded, because I bore the reproach of my youth.’ ²⁰Is Ephraim my dear son? Is he a darling child? For as often as I speak against him, I still earnestly remember him. therefore my heart yearns for him. I will surely have mercy on him,” says the LORD. ²¹“Set up road signs. Make guideposts. Set your heart toward the highway, even the way by which you went. Turn again, virgin of Israel. Turn again to these your cities. ²²How long will you go here and there, you backsliding daughter? For the LORD has created a new thing in the earth: a woman will encompass a man.” ²³The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: “Yet again they will use this speech in the land of Judah and in its cities, when I reverse their captivity: ‘The LORD bless you, habitation of righteousness, mountain of holiness.’ ²⁴Judah and all its cities will dwell therein together, the farmers, and those who go about with flocks. ²⁵For I have satiated the weary soul, and I have replenished every sorrowful soul.” ²⁶On this I awakened, and saw; and my sleep was sweet to me. ²⁷“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will sow the house of Israel and the house of Judah with the seed of man and with the seed of animal. ²⁸It will happen that, like as I have watched over them to pluck up and to break down and to overthrow and to destroy and to afflict, so I will watch over them to build and to plant,” says the LORD. ²⁹“In those days they will say no more, “‘The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children’s teeth are set on edge.’ ³⁰But everyone will die for his own iniquity. Every man who eats the sour grapes, his teeth will be set on edge. ³¹“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah, ³²not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt, which covenant of mine they broke, although I was a husband to them,” says the LORD. ³³“But this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days,” says the LORD: “I will put my law in their inward parts, and I will write it in their heart. I will be their God, and they shall be my people. ³⁴They will no longer each teach his neighbor, and every man teach his brother, saying, ‘Know the LORD;’ for they will all know me, from their least to

their greatest,” says the LORD, “for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.” ³⁵The LORD, who gives the sun for a light by day, and the ordinances of the moon and of the stars for a light by night, who stirs up the sea, so that its waves roar— the LORD of Hosts is his name, says: ³⁶“If these ordinances depart from before me,” says the LORD, “then the offspring of Israel also will cease from being a nation before me forever.” ³⁷The LORD says: “If heaven above can be measured, and the foundations of the earth searched out beneath, then I will also cast off all the offspring of Israel for all that they have done,” says the LORD. ³⁸“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that the city will be built to the LORD from the tower of Hananel to the gate of the corner. ³⁹The measuring line will go out further straight onward to the hill Gareb, and will turn toward Goah. ⁴⁰The whole valley of the dead bodies and of the ashes, and all the fields to the brook Kidron, to the corner of the horse gate toward the east, will be holy to the LORD. It will not be plucked up or thrown down any more forever.”

32This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the tenth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar. ²Now at that time the king of Babylon’s army was besieging Jerusalem. Jeremiah the prophet was shut up in the court of the guard, which was in the king of Judah’s house. ³For Zedekiah king of Judah had shut him up, saying, “Why do you prophesy, and say, ‘The LORD says, “Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he will take it; ⁴and Zedekiah king of Judah won’t escape out of the hand of the Kasdim, but will surely be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon, and will speak with him mouth to mouth, and his eyes will see his eyes; ⁵and he will bring Zedekiah to Babylon, and he will be there until I visit him,” says the LORD, “though you fight with the Kasdim, you will not prosper?”’” ⁶Jeremiah said, “The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ⁷‘Behold, Hanamel the son of Shallum your uncle will come to you, saying, “Buy my field that is in Anathoth; for the right of redemption is yours to buy it.”’” ⁸“So Hanamel my uncle’s son came to me in the court of the guard according to the LORD’s word, and said to me, ‘Please buy my field that is in Anathoth, which is in the land of Benjamin; for the right of inheritance is yours, and the redemption is yours. Buy it for yourself.’ “Then I knew that this was the LORD’s word. ⁹I bought the field that was in Anathoth of Hanamel my uncle’s son, and weighed him the money, even seventeen shekels ^{viii} of silver. ¹⁰I signed the deed, sealed it, called witnesses, and weighed the money in the balances to him. ¹¹So I took the deed of the purchase, both that which was sealed, containing the terms and conditions, and that which was open; ¹²and I delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of

^{viii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the presence of Hanamel my uncle's son, and in the presence of the witnesses who signed the deed of the purchase, before all the Jews who sat in the court of the guard. ¹³"I commanded Baruch before them, saying, ¹⁴the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Take these deeds, this deed of the purchase which is sealed, and this deed which is open, and put them in an earthen vessel, that they may last many days.' ¹⁵For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: 'Houses and fields and vineyards will yet again be bought in this land.' ¹⁶Now after I had delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of Neriah, I prayed to the LORD, saying, ¹⁷"Ah Lord GOD! Behold, you have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm. There is nothing too hard for you. ¹⁸You show loving kindness to thousands, and repay the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them. The great, the mighty God, the LORD of Hosts is your name: ¹⁹great in counsel, and mighty in work; whose eyes are open to all the ways of the children of men, to give everyone according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings; ²⁰who performed signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, even to this day, both in Israel and among other men; and made yourself a name, as it is today; ²¹and brought your people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs, with wonders, with a strong hand, with an outstretched arm, and with great terror; ²²and gave them this land, which you swore to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey. ²³They came in and possessed it, but they didn't obey your voice and didn't walk in your law. They have done nothing of all that you commanded them to do. Therefore you have caused all this evil to come upon them. ²⁴"Behold, siege ramps have been built against the city to take it. The city is given into the hand of the Kasdim who fight against it, because of the sword, of the famine, and of the pestilence. What you have spoken has happened. Behold, you see it. ²⁵You have said to me, Lord GOD, 'Buy the field for money, and call witnesses;' whereas the city is given into the hand of the Kasdim." ²⁶Then the LORD's word came to Jeremiah, saying, ²⁷"Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh. Is there anything too hard for me? ²⁸Therefore the LORD says: Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the Kasdim, and into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will take it. ²⁹The Kasdim, who fight against this city, will come and set this city on fire, and burn it with the houses on whose roofs they have offered incense to Baal, and poured out drink offerings to other gods, to provoke me to anger. ³⁰"For the children of Israel and the children of Judah have done only that which was evil in my sight from their youth; for the children of Israel have only provoked me to anger with the work of their hands, says the LORD. ³¹For this city has been to me a provocation of my anger and of my wrath from the day that they built it even to this day, so that I should remove

it from before my face, ³²because of all the evil of the children of Israel and of the children of Judah, which they have done to provoke me to anger—they, their kings, their princes, their priests, their prophets, the men of Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem. ³³They have turned their backs to me, and not their faces. Although I taught them, rising up early and teaching them, yet they have not listened to receive instruction. ³⁴But they set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to defile it. ³⁵They built the high places of Baal, which are in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to cause their sons and their daughters to pass through fire to Molech, which I didn't command them. It didn't even come into my mind, that they should do this abomination, to cause Judah to sin." ³⁶Now therefore the LORD, the God of Israel, says concerning this city, about which you say, "It is given into the hand of the king of Babylon by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence:" ³⁷"Behold, I will gather them out of all the countries where I have driven them in my anger, and in my wrath, and in great indignation; and I will bring them again to this place. I will cause them to dwell safely. ³⁸Then they will be my people, and I will be their God. ³⁹I will give them one heart and one way, that they may fear me forever, for their good and the good of their children after them. ⁴⁰I will make an everlasting covenant with them, that I will not turn away from following them, to do them good. I will put my fear in their hearts, that they may not depart from me. ⁴¹Yes, I will rejoice over them to do them good, and I will plant them in this land assuredly with my whole heart and with my whole soul." ⁴²For the LORD says: "Just as I have brought all this great evil on this people, so I will bring on them all the good that I have promised them. ⁴³Fields will be bought in this land, about which you say, 'It is desolate, without man or animal. It is given into the hand of the Kasdim.' ⁴⁴Men will buy fields for money, sign the deeds, seal them, and call witnesses, in the land of Benjamin, and in the places around Jerusalem, in the cities of Judah, in the cities of the hill country, in the cities of the lowland, and in the cities of the South; for I will cause their captivity to be reversed," says the LORD.

33Moreover the LORD's word came to Jeremiah the second time, while he was still locked up in the court of the guard, saying, ²"The LORD who does it, the LORD who forms it to establish it—the LORD is his name, says: ³Call to me, and I will answer you, and will show you great and difficult things, which you don't know.' ⁴For the LORD, the God of Israel, says concerning the houses of this city and concerning the houses of the kings of Judah, which are broken down to make a defense against the mounds and against the sword: ⁵"While men come to fight with the Kasdim, and to fill them with the dead bodies of men, whom I have killed in my anger and in my wrath, and

for all whose wickedness I have hidden my face from this city, ⁶behold, I will bring it health and healing, and I will cure them; and I will reveal to them abundance of peace and truth. ⁷I will restore the fortunes of Judah and Israel, and will build them as at the first. ⁸I will cleanse them from all their iniquity by which they have sinned against me. I will pardon all their iniquities by which they have sinned against me and by which they have transgressed against me. ⁹This city will be to me for a name of joy, for praise, and for glory, before all the nations of the earth, which will hear all the good that I do to them, and will fear and tremble for all the good and for all the peace that I provide to it.” ¹⁰The LORD says: “Yet again there will be heard in this place, about which you say, ‘It is waste, without man and without animal, even in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, that are desolate, without man and without inhabitant and without animal,’ ¹¹the voice of joy and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the voice of those who say, ‘Give thanks to the LORD of Hosts, for the LORD is good, for his loving kindness endures forever,’ who bring thanksgiving into the LORD’s house. For I will cause the captivity of the land to be reversed as at the first,” says the LORD. ¹²The LORD of Hosts says: “Yet again there will be in this place, which is waste, without man and without animal, and in all its cities, a habitation of shepherds causing their flocks to lie down. ¹³In the cities of the hill country, in the cities of the lowland, in the cities of the South, in the land of Benjamin, in the places around Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, the flocks will again pass under the hands of him who counts them,” says the LORD. ¹⁴“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will perform that good word which I have spoken concerning the house of Israel and concerning the house of Judah. ¹⁵“In those days and at that time, I will cause a Branch of righteousness to grow up to David. He will execute justice and righteousness in the land. ¹⁶In those days Judah will be saved, and Jerusalem will dwell safely. This is the name by which she will be called: The LORD our righteousness.” ¹⁷For the LORD says: “David will never lack a man to sit on the throne of the house of Israel. ¹⁸The Levitical priests won’t lack a man before me to offer burnt offerings, to burn meal offerings, and to do sacrifice continually.” ¹⁹The LORD’s word came to Jeremiah, saying, ²⁰“The LORD says: ‘If you can break my covenant of the day and my covenant of the night, so that there will not be day and night in their time, ²¹then my covenant could also be broken with David my servant, that he won’t have a son to reign on his throne; and with the Levitical priests, my ministers. ²²As the army of the sky can’t be counted, and the sand of the sea can’t be measured, so I will multiply the offspring of David my servant and the Levites who minister to me.’” ²³The LORD’s word came to Jeremiah, saying, ²⁴“Don’t consider what

this people has spoken, saying, ‘Has the LORD cast off the two families which he chose?’ Thus they despise my people, that they should be no more a nation before them.” ²⁵The LORD says: “If my covenant of day and night fails, if I have not appointed the ordinances of heaven and earth, ²⁶then I will also cast away the offspring of Jacob, and of David my servant, so that I will not take of his offspring to be rulers over the offspring of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; for I will cause their captivity to be reversed and will have mercy on them.”

34The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, with all his army, all the kingdoms of the earth that were under his dominion, and all the peoples, were fighting against Jerusalem and against all its cities, saying: ²“The LORD, the God of Israel, says, ‘Go, and speak to Zedekiah king of Judah, and tell him, the LORD says, “Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon and he will burn it with fire. ³You won’t escape out of his hand, but will surely be taken and delivered into his hand. Your eyes will see the eyes of the king of Babylon, and he will speak with you mouth to mouth. You will go to Babylon.”’ ⁴“Yet hear the LORD’s word, O Zedekiah king of Judah. The LORD says concerning you, ‘You won’t die by the sword. ⁵You will die in peace; and with the burnings of your fathers, the former kings who were before you, so they will make a burning for you. They will lament you, saying, “Ah Lord!” for I have spoken the word,’ says the LORD.” ⁶Then Jeremiah the prophet spoke all these words to Zedekiah king of Judah in Jerusalem, ⁷when the king of Babylon’s army was fighting against Jerusalem and against all the cities of Judah that were left, against Lachish and against Azekah; for these alone remained of the cities of Judah as fortified cities. ⁸The word came to Jeremiah from the LORD, after King Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people who were at Jerusalem, to proclaim liberty to them, ⁹that every man should let his male servant, and every man his female servant, who is a Hebrew or a Hebrewess, go free, that no one should make bondservants of them, of a Jew his brother. ¹⁰All the princes and all the people obeyed who had entered into the covenant, that everyone should let his male servant and everyone his female servant go free, that no one should make bondservants of them any more. They obeyed and let them go, ¹¹but afterwards they turned, and caused the servants and the handmaids whom they had let go free to return, and brought them into subjection for servants and for handmaids. ¹²Therefore the LORD’s word came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ¹³“The LORD, the God of Israel, says: ‘I made a covenant with your fathers in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage, saying: ¹⁴At the end of seven years, every man of you shall release his brother who is a Hebrew, who has been sold to you, and has served

you six years. You shall let him go free from you. But your fathers didn't listen to me, and didn't incline their ear. ¹⁵You had now turned, and had done that which is right in my eyes, in every man proclaiming liberty to his neighbor. You had made a covenant before me in the house which is called by my name; ¹⁶but you turned and profaned my name, and every man caused his servant and every man his handmaid, whom you had let go free at their pleasure, to return. You brought them into subjection, to be to you for servants and for handmaids.' ¹⁷Therefore the LORD says: "You have not listened to me, to proclaim liberty, every man to his brother, and every man to his neighbor. Behold, I proclaim to you a liberty," says the LORD, "to the sword, to the pestilence, and to the famine. I will make you be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth. ¹⁸I will give the men who have transgressed my covenant, who have not performed the words of the covenant which they made before me when they cut the calf in two and passed between its parts: ¹⁹the princes of Judah, the princes of Jerusalem, the eunuchs, the priests, and all the people of the land, who passed between the parts of the calf. ²⁰I will even give them into the hand of their enemies and into the hand of those who seek their life. Their dead bodies will be food for the birds of the sky and for the animals of the earth. ²¹"I will give Zedekiah king of Judah and his princes into the hands of their enemies, into the hands of those who seek their life and into the hands of the king of Babylon's army, who has gone away from you. ²²Behold, I will command," says the LORD, "and cause them to return to this city. They will fight against it, take it, and burn it with fire. I will make the cities of Judah a desolation, without inhabitant."

35The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, saying, ²"Go to the house of the Rechabites, and speak to them, and bring them into the LORD's house, into one of the rooms, and give them wine to drink." ³Then I took Jaazaniah the son of Jeremiah, the son of Habazziniah, with his brothers, all his sons, and the whole house of the Rechabites; ⁴and I brought them into the LORD's house, into the room of the sons of Hanan the son of Igdaliah, the man of God, which was by the room of the princes, which was above the room of Maaseiah the son of Shallum, the keeper of the threshold. ⁵I set before the sons of the house of the Rechabites bowls full of wine, and cups; and I said to them, "Drink wine!" ⁶But they said, "We will drink no wine; for Jonadab the son of Rechab, our father, commanded us, saying, 'You shall drink no wine, neither you nor your children, forever. ⁷You shall not build a house, sow seed, plant a vineyard, or have any; but all your days you shall dwell in tents, that you may live many days in the land in which you live as nomads.' ⁸We have obeyed the voice of Jonadab the son of Rechab, our father, in all

that he commanded us, to drink no wine all our days, we, our wives, our sons, or our daughters; ⁹and not to build houses for ourselves to dwell in. We have no vineyard, field, or seed; ¹⁰but we have lived in tents, and have obeyed, and done according to all that Jonadab our father commanded us. ¹¹But when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up into the land, we said, 'Come! Let's go to Jerusalem for fear of the army of the Kasdim, and for fear of the army of the Syrians; so we will dwell at Jerusalem.'" ¹²Then the LORD's word came to Jeremiah, saying, ¹³"The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Go and tell the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, "Will you not receive instruction to listen to my words?"' says the LORD. ¹⁴"The words of Jonadab the son of Rechab that he commanded his sons, not to drink wine, are performed; and to this day they drink none, for they obey their father's commandment; but I have spoken to you, rising up early and speaking, and you have not listened to me. ¹⁵I have sent also to you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, 'Every one of you must return now from his evil way, amend your doings, and don't go after other gods to serve them. Then you will dwell in the land which I have given to you and to your fathers;' but you have not inclined your ear, nor listened to me. ¹⁶The sons of Jonadab the son of Rechab have performed the commandment of their father which he commanded them, but this people has not listened to me.'" ¹⁷"Therefore the LORD, the God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will bring on Judah and on all the inhabitants of Jerusalem all the evil that I have pronounced against them, because I have spoken to them, but they have not heard; and I have called to them, but they have not answered.'" ¹⁸Jeremiah said to the house of the Rechabites, "The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Because you have obeyed the commandment of Jonadab your father, and kept all his precepts, and done according to all that he commanded you,' ¹⁹therefore the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Jonadab the son of Rechab will not lack a man to stand before me forever.'"

36In the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from the LORD, saying, ²"Take a scroll of a book, and write in it all the words that I have spoken to you against Israel, against Judah, and against all the nations, from the day I spoke to you, from the days of Josiah even to this day. ³It may be that the house of Judah will hear all the evil which I intend to do to them, that they may each return from his evil way; that I may forgive their iniquity and their sin." ⁴Then Jeremiah called Baruch the son of Neriah; and Baruch wrote from the mouth of Jeremiah all the LORD's words, which he had spoken to him, on a scroll of a book. ⁵Jeremiah commanded Baruch, saying, "I am restricted. I can't go into the LORD's house. ⁶Therefore

you go, and read from the scroll which you have written from my mouth, the LORD's words, in the ears of the people in the LORD's house on the fast day. Also you shall read them in the ears of all Judah who come out of their cities. ⁷It may be they will present their supplication before the LORD, and will each return from his evil way; for the LORD has pronounced great anger and wrath against this people." ⁸Baruch the son of Neriah did according to all that Jeremiah the prophet commanded him, reading in the book the LORD's words in the LORD's house. ⁹Now in the fifth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, in the ninth month, all the people in Jerusalem and all the people who came from the cities of Judah to Jerusalem, proclaimed a fast before the LORD. ¹⁰Then Baruch read the words of Jeremiah from the book in the LORD's house, in the room of Gemariah the son of Shaphan the scribe, in the upper court, at the entry of the new gate of the LORD's house, in the ears of all the people. ¹¹When Micaiah the son of Gemariah, the son of Shaphan, had heard out of the book all the LORD's words, ¹²he went down into the king's house, into the scribe's room; and behold, all the princes were sitting there, Elishama the scribe, Delaiah the son of Shemaiah, Elnathan the son of Achbor, Gemariah the son of Shaphan, Zedekiah the son of Hananiah, and all the princes. ¹³Then Micaiah declared to them all the words that he had heard, when Baruch read the book in the ears of the people. ¹⁴Therefore all the princes sent Jehudi the son of Nethaniah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, to Baruch, saying, "Take in your hand the scroll in which you have read in the ears of the people, and come." So Baruch the son of Neriah took the scroll in his hand, and came to them. ¹⁵They said to him, "Sit down now, and read it in our hearing." So Baruch read it in their hearing. ¹⁶Now when they had heard all the words, they turned in fear one toward another, and said to Baruch, "We will surely tell the king of all these words." ¹⁷They asked Baruch, saying, "Tell us now, how did you write all these words at his mouth?" ¹⁸Then Baruch answered them, "He dictated all these words to me with his mouth, and I wrote them with ink in the book." ¹⁹Then the princes said to Baruch, "You and Jeremiah go hide. Don't let anyone know where you are." ²⁰They went in to the king into the court, but they had laid up the scroll in the room of Elishama the scribe. Then they told all the words in the hearing of the king. ²¹So the king sent Jehudi to get the scroll, and he took it out of the room of Elishama the scribe. Jehudi read it in the hearing of the king, and in the hearing of all the princes who stood beside the king. ²²Now the king was sitting in the winter house in the ninth month, and there was a fire in the brazier burning before him. ²³When Jehudi had read three or four columns, the king cut it with the penknife, and cast it into the fire that was in the brazier, until all the scroll was consumed in the fire that was in the brazier. ²⁴The king

and his servants who heard all these words were not afraid, and didn't tear their garments. ²⁵Moreover Elnathan and Delaiah and Gemariah had made intercession to the king that he would not burn the scroll; but he would not listen to them. ²⁶The king commanded Jerahmeel the king's son, and Seraiah the son of Azriel, and Shelemiah the son of Abdeel, to arrest Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet; but the LORD hid them. ²⁷Then the LORD's word came to Jeremiah, after the king had burned the scroll, and the words which Baruch wrote at the mouth of Jeremiah, saying, ²⁸"Take again another scroll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first scroll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah has burned. ²⁹Concerning Jehoiakim king of Judah you shall say, 'The LORD says: "You have burned this scroll, saying, "Why have you written therein, saying, 'The king of Babylon will certainly come and destroy this land, and will cause to cease from there man and animal?'"'" ³⁰Therefore the LORD says concerning Jehoiakim king of Judah: "He will have no one to sit on David's throne. His dead body will be cast out in the day to the heat, and in the night to the frost. ³¹I will punish him, his offspring, and his servants for their iniquity. I will bring on them, on the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and on the men of Judah, all the evil that I have pronounced against them, but they didn't listen."'" ³²Then Jeremiah took another scroll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah, who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire; and many similar words were added to them.

37 Zedekiah the son of Josiah reigned as king instead of Coniah the son of Jehoiakim, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon made king in the land of Judah. ²But neither he, nor his servants, nor the people of the land, listened to the LORD's words, which he spoke by the prophet Jeremiah. ³Zedekiah the king sent Jehucal the son of Shelemiah and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, to the prophet Jeremiah, saying, "Pray now to the LORD our God for us." ⁴Now Jeremiah came in and went out among the people, for they had not put him into prison. ⁵Pharaoh's army had come out of Egypt; and when the Kasdim who were besieging Jerusalem heard news of them, they withdrew from Jerusalem. ⁶Then the LORD's word came to the prophet Jeremiah, saying, ⁷"The LORD, the God of Israel, says, 'You shall tell the king of Judah, who sent you to me to inquire of me: "Behold, Pharaoh's army, which has come out to help you, will return to Egypt into their own land. ⁸The Kasdim will come again, and fight against this city. They will take it and burn it with fire.'"'" ⁹"The LORD says, 'Don't deceive yourselves, saying, "The Kasdim will surely depart from us;" for they will not depart. ¹⁰For though you had struck the whole army of the Kasdim who fight against you, and only wounded men re-

mained among them, they would each rise up in his tent and burn this city with fire.”¹¹ When the army of the Kasdim had withdrawn from Jerusalem for fear of Pharaoh’s army,¹² then Jeremiah went out of Jerusalem to go into the land of Benjamin, to receive his portion there, in the middle of the people.¹³ When he was in Benjamin’s gate, a captain of the guard was there, whose name was Irijah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Hananiah; and he seized Jeremiah the prophet, saying, “You are defecting to the Kasdim!”¹⁴ Then Jeremiah said, “That is false! I am not defecting to the Kasdim.” But he didn’t listen to him; so Irijah seized Jeremiah, and brought him to the princes.¹⁵ The princes were angry with Jeremiah, and struck him, and put him in prison in the house of Jonathan the scribe; for they had made that the prison.¹⁶ When Jeremiah had come into the dungeon house and into the cells, and Jeremiah had remained there many days,¹⁷ then Zedekiah the king sent and had him brought out. The king asked him secretly in his house, “Is there any word from the LORD?” Jeremiah said, “There is.” He also said, “You will be delivered into the hand of the king of Babylon.”¹⁸ Moreover Jeremiah said to King Zedekiah, “How have I sinned against you, against your servants, or against this people, that you have put me in prison?”¹⁹ Now where are your prophets who prophesied to you, saying, ‘The king of Babylon will not come against you, nor against this land?’²⁰ Now please hear, my lord the king: please let my supplication be presented before you, that you not cause me to return to the house of Jonathan the scribe, lest I die there.”²¹ Then Zedekiah the king commanded, and they committed Jeremiah into the court of the guard. They gave him daily a loaf of bread out of the bakers’ street, until all the bread in the city was gone. Thus Jeremiah remained in the court of the guard.

38 Shephatiah the son of Mattan, Gedaliah the son of Pashhur, Jucal the son of Shelemiah, and Pashhur the son of Malchijah heard the words that Jeremiah spoke to all the people, saying,² “The LORD says, ‘He who remains in this city will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence, but he who goes out to the Kasdim will live. He will escape with his life and he will live.’”³ The LORD says, ‘This city will surely be given into the hand of the army of the king of Babylon, and he will take it.’”⁴ Then the princes said to the king, “Please let this man be put to death, because he weakens the hands of the men of war who remain in this city, and the hands of all the people, in speaking such words to them; for this man doesn’t seek the welfare of this people, but harm.”⁵ Zedekiah the king said, “Behold, he is in your hand; for the king can’t do anything to oppose you.”⁶ Then they took Jeremiah and threw him into the dungeon of Malchijah the king’s son, that was in the court of the guard. They let down Jeremiah with cords. In the dungeon there was no water, but mire; and

Jeremiah sank in the mire.⁷ Now when Ebedmelech the Ethiopian, a eunuch, who was in the king’s house, heard that they had put Jeremiah in the dungeon (the king was then sitting in Benjamin’s gate),⁸ Ebedmelech went out of the king’s house, and spoke to the king, saying,⁹ “My lord the king, these men have done evil in all that they have done to Jeremiah the prophet, whom they have cast into the dungeon. He is likely to die in the place where he is, because of the famine; for there is no more bread in the city.”¹⁰ Then the king commanded Ebedmelech the Ethiopian, saying, “Take from here thirty men with you, and take up Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon, before he dies.”¹¹ So Ebedmelech took the men with him, and went into the house of the king under the treasury, and took from there rags and worn-out garments, and let them down by cords into the dungeon to Jeremiah.¹² Ebedmelech the Ethiopian said to Jeremiah, “Now put these rags and worn-out garments under your armpits under the cords.” Jeremiah did so.¹³ So they lifted Jeremiah up with the cords, and took him up out of the dungeon; and Jeremiah remained in the court of the guard.¹⁴ Then Zedekiah the king sent and took Jeremiah the prophet to himself into the third entry that is in the LORD’s house. Then the king said to Jeremiah, “I will ask you something. Hide nothing from me.”¹⁵ Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, “If I declare it to you, will you not surely put me to death? If I give you counsel, you will not listen to me.”¹⁶ So Zedekiah the king swore secretly to Jeremiah, saying, “As the LORD lives, who made our souls, I will not put you to death, neither will I give you into the hand of these men who seek your life.”¹⁷ Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, “The LORD, the God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: ‘If you will go out to the king of Babylon’s princes, then your soul will live, and this city will not be burned with fire. You will live, along with your house.’”¹⁸ But if you will not go out to the king of Babylon’s princes, then this city will be given into the hand of the Kasdim, and they will burn it with fire, and you won’t escape out of their hand.”¹⁹ Zedekiah the king said to Jeremiah, “I am afraid of the Jews who have defected to the Kasdim, lest they deliver me into their hand, and they mock me.”²⁰ But Jeremiah said, “They won’t deliver you. Obey, I beg you, the LORD’s voice, in that which I speak to you; so it will be well with you, and your soul will live.”²¹ But if you refuse to go out, this is the word that the LORD has shown me:²² “Behold, all the women who are left in the king of Judah’s house will be brought out to the king of Babylon’s princes, and those women will say, ‘Your familiar friends have turned on you, and have prevailed over you. Your feet are sunk in the mire, they have turned away from you.’”²³ They will bring out all your wives and your children to the Kasdim. You won’t escape out of their hand, but will be taken by the hand of the king of Babylon. You will cause this city to be burned with fire.”²⁴ Then Zedekiah said to Jeremiah,

“Let no man know of these words, and you won’t die. ²⁵But if the princes hear that I have talked with you, and they come to you, and tell you, ‘Declare to us now what you have said to the king; don’t hide it from us, and we will not put you to death; also tell us what the king said to you;’ ²⁶then you shall tell them, ‘I presented my supplication before the king, that he would not cause me to return to Jonathan’s house, to die there.’” ²⁷Then all the princes came to Jeremiah, and asked him; and he told them according to all these words that the king had commanded. So they stopped speaking with him, for the matter was not perceived. ²⁸So Jeremiah stayed in the court of the guard until the day that Jerusalem was taken.

39In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the tenth month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and all his army came against Jerusalem, and besieged it. ²In the eleventh year of Zedekiah, in the fourth month, the ninth day of the month, a breach was made in the city. ³All the princes of the king of Babylon came in, and sat in the middle gate: Nergal Sharezer, Samgarnebo, Sarsechim, Rab-saris, Nergal Sharezer, Rabmag, with all the rest of the princes of the king of Babylon. ⁴When Zedekiah the king of Judah and all the men of war saw them, then they fled and went out of the city by night, by the way of the king’s garden, through the gate between the two walls; and he went out toward the Arabah. ⁵But the army of the Kasdim pursued them, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho. When they had taken him, they brought him up to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath; and he pronounced judgment on him. ⁶Then the king of Babylon killed Zedekiah’s sons in Riblah before his eyes. The king of Babylon also killed all the nobles of Judah. ⁷Moreover he put out Zedekiah’s eyes and bound him in fetters, to carry him to Babylon. ⁸The Kasdim burned the king’s house and the people’s houses with fire and broke down the walls of Jerusalem. ⁹Then Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive into Babylon the rest of the people who remained in the city, the deserters also who fell away to him, and the rest of the people who remained. ¹⁰But Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard left of the poor of the people, who had nothing, in the land of Judah, and gave them vineyards and fields at the same time. ¹¹Now Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon commanded Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard concerning Jeremiah, saying, ¹²“Take him and take care of him. Do him no harm; but do to him even as he tells you.” ¹³So Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard, Nebushazban, Rab-saris, and Nergal Sharezer, Rabmag, and all the chief officers of the king of Babylon ¹⁴sent and took Jeremiah out of the court of the guard, and committed him to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, that he should bring him home. So he lived among the people. ¹⁵Now the LORD’s word came to Jeremiah while he

was shut up in the court of the guard, saying, ¹⁶“Go, and speak to Ebedmelech the Ethiopian, saying, ‘The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: “Behold, I will bring my words on this city for evil, and not for good; and they will be accomplished before you in that day. ¹⁷But I will deliver you in that day,” says the LORD; “and you will not be given into the hand of the men of whom you are afraid. ¹⁸For I will surely save you. You won’t fall by the sword, but you will escape with your life, because you have put your trust in me,” says the LORD.’”

40The word which came to Jeremiah from the LORD, after Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard had let him go from Ramah, when he had taken him being bound in chains among all the captives of Jerusalem and Judah who were carried away captive to Babylon. ²The captain of the guard took Jeremiah and said to him, “The LORD your God pronounced this evil on this place; ³and the LORD has brought it, and done according as he spoke. Because you have sinned against the LORD, and have not obeyed his voice, therefore this thing has come on you. ⁴Now, behold, I release you today from the chains which are on your hand. If it seems good to you to come with me into Babylon, come, and I will take care of you; but if it seems bad to you to come with me into Babylon, don’t. Behold, all the land is before you. Where it seems good and right to you to go, there go.” ⁵Now while he had not yet gone back, “Go back then,” he said, “to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon has made governor over the cities of Judah, and dwell with him among the people; or go wherever it seems right to you to go.” So the captain of the guard gave him food and a present, and let him go. ⁶Then Jeremiah went to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah, and lived with him among the people who were left in the land. ⁷Now when all the captains of the forces who were in the fields, even they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam governor in the land, and had committed to him men, women, children, and of the poorest of the land, of those who were not carried away captive to Babylon, ⁸then Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and Yochanan and Jonathan the sons of Kareah, and Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth, and the sons of Ephai the Netophathite, and Jezaniah the son of the Maacathite, they and their men came to Gedaliah to Mizpah. ⁹Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan swore to them and to their men, saying, “Don’t be afraid to serve the Kasdim. Dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it will be well with you. ¹⁰As for me, behold, I will dwell at Mizpah, to stand before the Kasdim who will come to us; but you, gather wine and summer fruits and oil, and put them in your vessels, and dwell in your cities that you have taken.” ¹¹Likewise when all the Jews who were in Moab, and among the children of Ammon, and in Edom, and who were in all the countries,

heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant of Judah, and that he had set over them Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, ¹²then all the Jews returned out of all places where they were driven, and came to the land of Judah, to Gedaliah, to Mizpah, and gathered very much wine and summer fruits. ¹³Moreover Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were in the fields, came to Gedaliah to Mizpah, ¹⁴and said to him, “Do you know that Baalis the king of the children of Ammon has sent Ishmael the son of Nethaniah to take your life?” But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam didn’t believe them. ¹⁵Then Yochanan the son of Kareah spoke to Gedaliah in Mizpah secretly, saying, “Please let me go, and I will kill Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and no man will know it. Why should he take your life, that all the Jews who are gathered to you should be scattered, and the remnant of Judah perish?” ¹⁶But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam said to Yochanan the son of Kareah, “You shall not do this thing, for you speak falsely of Ishmael.”

⁴¹Now in the seventh month, Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of the royal offspring and one of the chief officers of the king, and ten men with him, came to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and there they ate bread together in Mizpah. ²Then Ishmael the son of Nethaniah arose, and the ten men who were with him, and struck Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan with the sword and killed him, whom the king of Babylon had made governor over the land. ³Ishmael also killed all the Jews who were with Gedaliah at Mizpah, and the Kasdim men of war who were found there. ⁴The second day after he had killed Gedaliah, and no man knew it, ⁵men came from Shechem, from Shiloh, and from Samaria, even eighty men, having their beards shaved and their clothes torn, and having cut themselves, with meal offerings and frankincense in their hand, to bring them to the LORD’s house. ⁶Ishmael the son of Nethaniah went out from Mizpah to meet them, weeping all along as he went, and as he met them, he said to them, “Come to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam.” ⁷It was so, when they came into the middle of the city, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah killed them, and cast them into the middle of the pit, he, and the men who were with him. ⁸But ten men were found among those who said to Ishmael, “Don’t kill us; for we have stores hidden in the field, of wheat, and of barley, and of oil, and of honey.” So he stopped, and didn’t kill them among their brothers. ⁹Now the pit in which Ishmael cast all the dead bodies of the men whom he had killed, by the side of Gedaliah (this was that which Asa the king had made for fear of Baasha king of Israel), Ishmael the son of Nethaniah filled it with those who were killed. ¹⁰Then Ishmael carried away captive all of the people who were left in Mizpah, even the king’s daughters, and all the people who remained in Mizpah, whom Nebuzaradan the captain of

the guard had committed to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam. Ishmael the son of Nethaniah carried them away captive, and departed to go over to the children of Ammon. ¹¹But when Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, heard of all the evil that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had done, ¹²then they took all the men, and went to fight with Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and found him by the great waters that are in Gibeon. ¹³Now when all the people who were with Ishmael saw Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, then they were glad. ¹⁴So all the people who Ishmael had carried away captive from Mizpah turned about and came back, and went to Yochanan the son of Kareah. ¹⁵But Ishmael the son of Nethaniah escaped from Yochanan with eight men, and went to the children of Ammon. ¹⁶Then Yochanan the son of Kareah and all the captains of the forces who were with him took all the remnant of the people whom he had recovered from Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, from Mizpah, after he had killed Gedaliah the son of Ahikam—the men of war, with the women, the children, and the eunuchs, whom he had brought back from Gibeon. ¹⁷They departed and lived in Geruth Chimham, which is by Bethlehem, to go to enter into Egypt ¹⁸because of the Kasdim; for they were afraid of them, because Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had killed Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon made governor over the land.

⁴²Then all the captains of the forces, and Yochanan the son of Kareah, and Jezaniah the son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least even to the greatest, came near, ²and said to Jeremiah the prophet, “Please let our supplication be presented before you, and pray for us to the LORD your God, even for all this remnant, for we are left but a few of many, as your eyes see us, ³that the LORD your God may show us the way in which we should walk, and the things that we should do.” ⁴Then Jeremiah the prophet said to them, “I have heard you. Behold, I will pray to the LORD your God according to your words; and it will happen that whatever thing the LORD answers you, I will declare it to you. I will keep nothing back from you.” ⁵Then they said to Jeremiah, “May the LORD be a true and faithful witness among us, if we don’t do according to all the word with which the LORD your God sends you to tell us. ⁶Whether it is good, or whether it is bad, we will obey the voice of the LORD our God, to whom we send you; that it may be well with us, when we obey the voice of the LORD our God.” ⁷After ten days, the LORD’s word came to Jeremiah. ⁸Then he called Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, and all the people from the least even to the greatest, ⁹and said to them, “The LORD, the God of Israel, to whom you sent me to present your supplication before him, says: ¹⁰‘If you will still live in this land, then I will

build you, and not pull you down, and I will plant you, and not pluck you up; for I grieve over the distress that I have brought on you. ¹¹Don't be afraid of the king of Babylon, of whom you are afraid. Don't be afraid of him,' says the LORD, 'for I am with you to save you, and to deliver you from his hand. ¹²I will grant you mercy, that he may have mercy on you, and cause you to return to your own land. ¹³"But if you say, "We will not dwell in this land," so that you don't obey the LORD your God's voice, ¹⁴saying, "No, but we will go into the land of Egypt, where we will see no war, nor hear the sound of the shofar, nor have hunger of bread; and there we will dwell;" ¹⁵now therefore hear the LORD's word, O remnant of Judah! The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says, 'If you indeed set your faces to enter into Egypt, and go to live there, ¹⁶then it will happen that the sword, which you fear, will overtake you there in the land of Egypt; and the famine, about which you are afraid, will follow close behind you there in Egypt; and you will die there. ¹⁷So will it be with all the men who set their faces to go into Egypt to live there. They will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence. None of them will remain or escape from the evil that I will bring on them.' ¹⁸For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'As my anger and my wrath has been poured out on the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so my wrath will be poured out on you, when you enter into Egypt; and you will be an object of horror, an astonishment, a curse, and a reproach; and you will see this place no more.' ¹⁹"The LORD has spoken concerning you, remnant of Judah, 'Don't go into Egypt!' Know certainly that I have testified to you today. ²⁰For you have dealt deceitfully against your own souls; for you sent me to the LORD your God, saying, 'Pray for us to the LORD our God; and according to all that the LORD our God says, so declare to us, and we will do it.' ²¹I have declared it to you today; but you have not obeyed the LORD your God's voice in anything for which he has sent me to you. ²²Now therefore know certainly that you will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence in the place where you desire to go to live."

43When Jeremiah had finished speaking to all the people all the words of the LORD their God, with which the LORD their God had sent him to them, even all these words, ²then Azariah the son of Hoshaiiah, Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the proud men spoke, saying to Jeremiah, "You speak falsely. The LORD our God has not sent you to say, 'You shall not go into Egypt to live there;' ³but Baruch the son of Neriah has turned you against us, to deliver us into the hand of the Kasdim, that they may put us to death or carry us away captive to Babylon." ⁴So Yochanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, and all the people, didn't obey the LORD's voice, to dwell in the land of Judah. ⁵But Yochanan the son of Kareah and all the captains of the forces took all the

remnant of Judah, who had returned from all the nations where they had been driven, to live in the land of Judah—⁶the men, the women, the children, the king's daughters, and every person who Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard had left with Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan; and Jeremiah the prophet, and Baruch the son of Neriah. ⁷They came into the land of Egypt, for they didn't obey the LORD's voice; and they came to Tahpanhes. ⁸Then the LORD's word came to Jeremiah in Tahpanhes, saying, ⁹"Take great stones in your hand and hide them in mortar in the brick work which is at the entry of Pharaoh's house in Tahpanhes, in the sight of the men of Judah. ¹⁰Tell them, the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will send and take Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will set his throne on these stones that I have hidden; and he will spread his royal pavilion over them. ¹¹He will come, and will strike the land of Egypt; such as are for death will be put to death, and such as are for captivity to captivity, and such as are for the sword to the sword. ¹²I will kindle a fire in the houses of the gods of Egypt. He will burn them, and carry them away captive. He will array himself with the land of Egypt, as a shepherd puts on his garment; and he will go out from there in peace. ¹³He will also break the pillars of Beth Shemesh that is in the land of Egypt; and he will burn the houses of the gods of Egypt with fire.'"

44The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews who lived in the land of Egypt, who lived at Migdol, and at Tahpanhes, and at Memphis, and in the country of Pathros, saying, ²"The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'You have seen all the evil that I have brought on Jerusalem, and on all the cities of Judah. Behold, today they are a desolation, and no man dwells in them, ³because of their wickedness which they have committed to provoke me to anger, in that they went to burn incense, to serve other gods that they didn't know, neither they, nor you, nor your fathers. ⁴However I sent to you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, "Oh, don't do this abominable thing that I hate." ⁵But they didn't listen and didn't incline their ear. They didn't turn from their wickedness, to stop burning incense to other gods. ⁶Therefore my wrath and my anger was poured out, and was kindled in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; and they are wasted and desolate, as it is today.' ⁷"Therefore now the LORD, the God of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Why do you commit great evil against your own souls, to cut off from yourselves man and woman, infant and nursing child out of the middle of Judah, to leave yourselves no one remaining, ⁸in that you provoke me to anger with the works of your hands, burning incense to other gods in the land of Egypt where you have gone to live, that you may be cut off, and that you may be a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the

earth? ⁹Have you forgotten the wickedness of your fathers, the wickedness of the kings of Judah, the wickedness of their wives, your own wickedness, and the wickedness of your wives which they committed in the land of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem? ¹⁰They are not humbled even to this day, neither have they feared, nor walked in my law, nor in my statutes, that I set before you and before your fathers.' ¹¹"Therefore the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will set my face against you for evil, even to cut off all Judah. ¹²I will take the remnant of Judah that have set their faces to go into the land of Egypt to live there, and they will all be consumed. They will fall in the land of Egypt. They will be consumed by the sword and by the famine. They will die, from the least even to the greatest, by the sword and by the famine. They will be an object of horror, an astonishment, a curse, and a reproach. ¹³For I will punish those who dwell in the land of Egypt, as I have punished Jerusalem, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence; ¹⁴so that none of the remnant of Judah, who have gone into the land of Egypt to live there, will escape or be left to return into the land of Judah, to which they have a desire to return to dwell there; for no one will return except those who will escape.'" ¹⁵Then all the men who knew that their wives burned incense to other gods, and all the women who stood by, a great assembly, even all the people who lived in the land of Egypt, in Pathros, answered Jeremiah, saying, ¹⁶"As for the word that you have spoken to us in the LORD's name, we will not listen to you. ¹⁷But we will certainly perform every word that has gone out of our mouth, to burn incense to the queen of the sky and to pour out drink offerings to her, as we have done, we and our fathers, our kings and our princes, in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; for then had we plenty of food, and were well, and saw no evil. ¹⁸But since we stopped burning incense to the queen of the sky, and pouring out drink offerings to her, we have lacked all things, and have been consumed by the sword and by the famine." ¹⁹The women said, "When we burned incense to the queen of the sky and poured out drink offerings to her, did we make her cakes to worship her, and pour out drink offerings to her, without our husbands?" ²⁰Then Jeremiah said to all the people—to the men and to the women, even to all the people who had given him an answer, saying, ²¹"The incense that you burned in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, you and your fathers, your kings and your princes, and the people of the land, didn't the LORD remember them, and didn't it come into his mind? ²²Thus the LORD could no longer bear it, because of the evil of your doings and because of the abominations which you have committed. Therefore your land has become a desolation, an astonishment, and a curse, without inhabitant, as it is today. ²³Because you have burned incense and because you have sinned against the LORD, and have not

obeyed the LORD's voice, nor walked in his law, nor in his statutes, nor in his testimonies; therefore this evil has happened to you, as it is today." ²⁴Moreover Jeremiah said to all the people, including all the women, "Hear the LORD's word, all Judah who are in the land of Egypt! ²⁵The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says, 'You and your wives have both spoken with your mouths, and with your hands have fulfilled it, saying, "We will surely perform our vows that we have vowed, to burn incense to the queen of the sky, and to pour out drink offerings to her." ' "Establish then your vows, and perform your vows.' ²⁶"Therefore hear the LORD's word, all Judah who dwell in the land of Egypt: 'Behold, I have sworn by my great name,' says the LORD, 'that my name will no more be named in the mouth of any man of Judah in all the land of Egypt, saying, "As the Lord GOD lives." ' ²⁷Behold, I watch over them for evil, and not for good; and all the men of Judah who are in the land of Egypt will be consumed by the sword and by the famine, until they are all gone. ²⁸Those who escape the sword will return out of the land of Egypt into the land of Judah few in number. All the remnant of Judah, who have gone into the land of Egypt to live there, will know whose word will stand, mine or theirs. ²⁹"This will be the sign to you,' says the LORD, 'that I will punish you in this place, that you may know that my words will surely stand against you for evil.' ³⁰The LORD says, 'Behold, I will give Pharaoh Hophra king of Egypt into the hand of his enemies and into the hand of those who seek his life, just as I gave Zedekiah king of Judah into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, who was his enemy and sought his life.'"

⁴⁵The message that Jeremiah the prophet spoke to Baruch the son of Neriah, when he wrote these words in a book at the mouth of Jeremiah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, saying, ²"The LORD, the God of Israel, says to you, Baruch: ³'You said, "Woe is me now! For the LORD has added sorrow to my pain! I am weary with my groaning, and I find no rest." ' ⁴"You shall tell him, the LORD says: 'Behold, that which I have built, I will break down, and that which I have planted I will pluck up; and this in the whole land. ⁵Do you seek great things for yourself? Don't seek them; for, behold, I will bring evil on all flesh,' says the LORD, 'but I will let you escape with your life wherever you go.'"

⁴⁶The LORD's word which came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning the nations. ²Of Egypt: concerning the army of Pharaoh Necho king of Egypt, which was by the river Euphrates in Carchemish, which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon struck in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah. ³"Prepare the buckler and shield, and draw near to battle! ⁴Harness the horses, and get up, you horsemen, and stand up with your helmets. Polish

the spears, put on the coats of mail. ⁵Why have I seen it? They are dismayed and are turned backward. Their mighty ones are beaten down, have fled in haste, and don't look back. Terror is on every side," says the LORD. ⁶"Don't let the swift flee away, nor the mighty man escape. In the north by the river Euphrates they have stumbled and fallen. ⁷"Who is this who rises up like the Nile, like rivers whose waters surge? ⁸Egypt rises up like the Nile, like rivers whose waters surge. He says, 'I will rise up. I will cover the earth. I will destroy cities and its inhabitants.' ⁹Go up, you horses! Rage, you chariots! Let the mighty men go out: Cush and Put, who handle the shield; and the Ludim, who handle and bend the bow. ¹⁰For that day is of the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, a day of vengeance, that he may avenge himself of his adversaries. The sword will devour and be satiated, and will drink its fill of their blood; for the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, has a sacrifice in the north country by the river Euphrates. ¹¹Go up into Gilead, and take balm, virgin daughter of Egypt. You use many medicines in vain. There is no healing for you. ¹²The nations have heard of your shame, and the earth is full of your cry; for the mighty man has stumbled against the mighty, they both fall together." ¹³The word that the LORD spoke to Jeremiah the prophet, how that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon should come and strike the land of Egypt: ¹⁴"Declare in Egypt, publish in Migdol, and publish in Memphis and in Tahpanhes; say, 'Stand up, and prepare, for the sword has devoured around you.' ¹⁵Why are your strong ones swept away? They didn't stand, because the LORD pushed them. ¹⁶He made many to stumble. Yes, they fell on one another. They said, 'Arise! Let's go again to our own people, and to the land of our birth, from the oppressing sword.' ¹⁷They cried there, 'Pharaoh king of Egypt is but a noise; he has let the appointed time pass by.' ¹⁸"As I live," says the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts, "surely like Tabor among the mountains, and like Carmel by the sea, so he will come. ¹⁹You daughter who dwells in Egypt, furnish yourself to go into captivity; for Memphis will become a desolation, and will be burned up, without inhabitant. ²⁰"Egypt is a very beautiful heifer; but destruction out of the north has come. It has come. ²¹Also her hired men in the middle of her are like calves of the stall, for they also are turned back. They have fled away together. They didn't stand, for the day of their calamity has come on them, the time of their visitation. ²²Its sound will go like the serpent, for they will march with an army, and come against her with axes, as wood cutters. ²³They will cut down her forest," says the LORD, "though it can't be searched; because they are more than the locusts, and are innumerable. ²⁴The daughter of Egypt will be disappointed; she will be delivered into the hand of the people of the north." ²⁵The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Behold, I will punish Amon of No, and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with her gods and her kings, even Pharaoh,

and those who trust in him. ²⁶I will deliver them into the hand of those who seek their lives, and into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of his servants. Afterwards it will be inhabited, as in the days of old," says the LORD. ²⁷"But don't you be afraid, Jacob my servant. Don't be dismayed, Israel; for, behold, I will save you from afar, and your offspring from the land of their captivity. Jacob will return, and will be quiet and at ease. No one will make him afraid. ²⁸Don't be afraid, O Jacob my servant," says the LORD, "for I am with you; for I will make a full end of all the nations where I have driven you, but I will not make a full end of you, but I will correct you in measure, and will in no way leave you unpunished."

47The LORD's word that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning the Philistines, before Pharaoh struck Gaza. ²The LORD says: "Behold, waters rise up out of the north, and will become an overflowing stream, and will overflow the land and all that is therein, the city and those who dwell therein. The men will cry, and all the inhabitants of the land will wail. ³At the noise of the stamping of the hoofs of his strong ones, at the rushing of his chariots, at the rumbling of his wheels, the fathers don't look back for their children because their hands are so feeble, ⁴because of the day that comes to destroy all the Philistines, to cut off from Tyre and Sidon every helper who remains; for the LORD will destroy the Philistines, the remnant of the isle of Caphtor. ⁵Baldness has come on Gaza; Ashkelon is brought to nothing. You remnant of their valley, how long will you cut yourself? ⁶"You sword of the LORD, how long will it be before you are quiet? Put yourself back into your scabbard; rest, and be still.' ⁷"How can you be quiet, since the LORD has given you a command? Against Ashkelon, and against the seashore, there he has appointed it."

48Of Moab. The LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: "Woe to Nebo! For it is laid waste. Kiriathaim is disappointed. It is taken. Misgab ^{ix} is put to shame and broken down. ²The praise of Moab is no more. In Heshbon they have devised evil against her: 'Come! Let's cut her off from being a nation.' You also, Madmen, will be brought to silence. The sword will pursue you. ³The sound of a cry from Horonaim, desolation and great destruction! ⁴Moab is destroyed. Her little ones have caused a cry to be heard. ⁵For they will go up by the ascent of Luhith with continual weeping. For at the descent of Horonaim they have heard the distress of the cry of destruction. ⁶Flee! Save your lives! Be like the juniper bush in the wilderness. ⁷For, because you have trusted in your works and in your treasures, you also will be taken. Chemosh will go out into captivity, his priests and his princes together. ⁸The

^{ix}or, The stronghold

destroyer will come on every city, and no city will escape; the valley also will perish, and the plain will be destroyed, as the LORD has spoken. ⁹Give wings to Moab, that she may fly and get herself away: and her cities will become a desolation, without anyone to dwell in them. ¹⁰“Cursed is he who does the work of the LORD negligently; and cursed is he who keeps back his sword from blood. ¹¹“Moab has been at ease from his youth, and he has settled on his dregs, and has not been emptied from vessel to vessel, neither has he gone into captivity; therefore his taste remains in him, and his scent is not changed. ¹²Therefore behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will send to him those who pour off, and they will pour him off; and they will empty his vessels, and break their containers in pieces. ¹³Moab will be ashamed of Chemosh, as the house of Israel was ashamed of Bethel, their confidence. ¹⁴“How do you say, ‘We are mighty men, and valiant men for the war’? ¹⁵Moab is laid waste, and they have gone up into his cities, and his chosen young men have gone down to the slaughter,” says the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁶“The calamity of Moab is near to come, and his affliction hurries fast. ¹⁷All you who are around him, bemoan him; and all you who know his name, say, ‘How the strong staff is broken, the beautiful rod!’ ¹⁸“You daughter who dwells in Dibon, come down from your glory, and sit in thirst; for the destroyer of Moab has come up against you. He has destroyed your strongholds. ¹⁹Inhabitant of Aroer, stand by the way and watch. Ask him who flees, and her who escapes; say, ‘What has been done?’ ²⁰Moab is disappointed; for it is broken down. Wail and cry! Tell it by the Arnon, that Moab is laid waste. ²¹Judgment has come on the plain country—on Holon, on Jahzah, on Mephaath, ²²on Dibon, on Nebo, on Beth Diblathaim, ²³on Kiriathaim, on Beth Gamul, on Beth Meon, ²⁴on Kerioth, on Bozrah, and on all the cities of the land of Moab, far or near. ²⁵The horn of Moab is cut off, and his arm is broken,” says the LORD. ²⁶“Make him drunk, for he magnified himself against the LORD. Moab will wallow in his vomit, and he also will be in derision. ²⁷For wasn’t Israel a derision to you? Was he found among thieves? For as often as you speak of him, you shake your head. ²⁸You inhabitants of Moab, leave the cities, and dwell in the rock. Be like the dove that makes her nest over the mouth of the abyss. ²⁹“We have heard of the pride of Moab. He is very proud in his loftiness, his pride, his arrogance, and the arrogance of his heart. ³⁰I know his wrath,” says the LORD, “that it is nothing; his boastings have done nothing. ³¹Therefore I will wail for Moab. Yes, I will cry out for all Moab. They will mourn for the men of Kir Heres. ³²With more than the weeping of Jazer I will weep for you, vine of Sibmah. Your branches passed over the sea. They reached even to the sea of Jazer. The destroyer has fallen on your summer fruits and on your vintage. ³³Gladness and joy is taken away from the fruitful field and from the land of Moab. I have caused wine

to cease from the wine presses. No one will tread with shouting. The shouting will be no shouting. ³⁴From the cry of Heshbon even to Elealeh, even to Jahaz they have uttered their voice, from Zoar even to Horonaim, to Eglath Shelishiyah; for the waters of Nimrim will also become desolate. ³⁵Moreover I will cause to cease in Moab,” says the LORD, “him who offers in the high place, and him who burns incense to his gods. ³⁶Therefore my heart sounds for Moab like flutes, and my heart sounds like flutes for the men of Kir Heres. Therefore the abundance that he has gotten has perished. ³⁷For every head is bald, and every beard clipped. There are cuttings on all the hands, and sackcloth on the waist. ³⁸On all the housetops of Moab, and in its streets, there is lamentation everywhere; for I have broken Moab like a vessel in which no one delights,” says the LORD. ³⁹“How it is broken down! How they wail! How Moab has turned the back with shame! So will Moab become a derision and a terror to all who are around him.” ⁴⁰For the LORD says: “Behold, he will fly as an eagle, and will spread out his wings against Moab. ⁴¹Kerioth is taken, and the strongholds are seized. The heart of the mighty men of Moab at that day will be as the heart of a woman in her pangs. ⁴²Moab will be destroyed from being a people, because he has magnified himself against the LORD. ⁴³Terror, the pit, and the snare are on you, inhabitant of Moab,” says the LORD. ⁴⁴“He who flees from the terror will fall into the pit; and he who gets up out of the pit will be taken in the snare, for I will bring on him, even on Moab, the year of their visitation,” says the LORD. ⁴⁵“Those who fled stand without strength under the shadow of Heshbon; for a fire has gone out of Heshbon, and a flame from the middle of Sihon, and has devoured the corner of Moab, and the crown of the head of the tumultuous ones. ⁴⁶Woe to you, O Moab! The people of Chemosh are undone; for your sons are taken away captive, and your daughters into captivity. ⁴⁷“Yet I will reverse the captivity of Moab in the latter days,” says the LORD. Thus far is the judgment of Moab.

49Of the children of Ammon. The LORD says: “Has Israel no sons? Has he no heir? Why then does Malcam possess Gad, and his people dwell in its cities? ²Therefore behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will cause an alarm of war to be heard against Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and it will become a desolate heap, and her daughters will be burned with fire; then Israel will possess those who possessed him,” says the LORD. ³“Wail, Heshbon, for Ai is laid waste! Cry, you daughters of Rabbah! Clothe yourself in sackcloth. Lament, and run back and forth among the fences; for Malcam will go into captivity, his priests and his princes together. ⁴Why do you boast in the valleys, your flowing valley, backsliding daughter? You trusted in her treasures, saying, ‘Who will come to me?’ ⁵Behold, I will bring a terror on you,” says the Lord,

the LORD of Hosts, “from all who are around you. All of you will be driven completely out, and there will be no one to gather together the fugitives. ⁶“But afterward I will reverse the captivity of the children of Ammon,” says the LORD. ⁷Of Edom, the LORD of Hosts says: “Is wisdom no more in Teman? Has counsel perished from the prudent? Has their wisdom vanished? ⁸Flee! Turn back! Dwell in the depths, inhabitants of Dedan; for I will bring the calamity of Esau on him when I visit him. ⁹If grape gatherers came to you, would they not leave some gleaning grapes? If thieves came by night, wouldn’t they steal until they had enough? ¹⁰But I have made Esau bare, I have uncovered his secret places, and he will not be able to hide himself. His offspring is destroyed, with his brothers and his neighbors; and he is no more. ¹¹Leave your fatherless children. I will preserve them alive. Let your widows trust in me.” ¹²For the LORD says: “Behold, they to whom it didn’t pertain to drink of the cup will certainly drink; and are you he who will altogether go unpunished? You won’t go unpunished, but you will surely drink. ¹³For I have sworn by myself,” says the LORD, “that Bozrah will become an astonishment, a reproach, a waste, and a curse. All its cities will be perpetual wastes.” ¹⁴I have heard news from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent among the nations, saying, “Gather yourselves together! Come against her! Rise up to the battle!” ¹⁵“For, behold, I have made you small among the nations, and despised among men. ¹⁶As for your terror, the pride of your heart has deceived you, O you who dwell in the clefts of the rock, who hold the height of the hill, though you should make your nest as high as the eagle, I will bring you down from there,” says the LORD. ¹⁷“Edom will become an astonishment. Everyone who passes by it will be astonished, and will hiss at all its plagues. ¹⁸As in the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah and its neighbor cities,” says the LORD, “no man will dwell there, neither will any son of man live therein. ¹⁹“Behold, he will come up like a lion from the pride of the Jordan against the strong habitation; for I will suddenly make them run away from it, and whoever is chosen, I will appoint him over it. For who is like me? Who will appoint me a time? Who is the shepherd who will stand before me?” ²⁰Therefore hear the counsel of the LORD, that he has taken against Edom, and his purposes that he has purposed against the inhabitants of Teman: Surely they will drag them away, the little ones of the flock. Surely he will make their habitation desolate over them. ²¹The earth trembles at the noise of their fall; there is a cry, the noise which is heard in the Sea of Suf. ²²Behold, he will come up and fly as the eagle, and spread out his wings against Bozrah. The heart of the mighty men of Edom at that day will be as the heart of a woman in her pangs. ²³Of Damascus: “Hamath and Arpad are confounded, for they have heard evil news. They have melted away. There is sorrow on the sea. It can’t be quiet. ²⁴Damascus has

grown feeble, she turns herself to flee, and trembling has seized her. Anguish and sorrows have taken hold of her, as of a woman in travail. ²⁵How is the city of praise not forsaken, the city of my joy? ²⁶Therefore her young men will fall in her streets, and all the men of war will be brought to silence in that day,” says the LORD of Hosts. ²⁷“I will kindle a fire in the wall of Damascus, and it will devour the palaces of Ben Hadad.” ²⁸Of Kedar, and of the kingdoms of Hazor, which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon struck, The LORD says: “Arise, go up to Kedar, and destroy the children of the east. ²⁹They will take their tents and their flocks. they will carry away for themselves their curtains, all their vessels, and their camels; and they will cry to them, ‘Terror on every side!’ ³⁰Flee! Wander far off! Dwell in the depths, you inhabitants of Hazor,” says the LORD; “for Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has taken counsel against you, and has conceived a purpose against you. ³¹Arise! Go up to a nation that is at ease, that dwells without care,” says the LORD; “that has neither gates nor bars, that dwells alone. ³²Their camels will be a booty, and the multitude of their livestock a plunder. I will scatter to all winds those who have the corners of their beards cut off; and I will bring their calamity from every side of them,” says the LORD. ³³Hazor will be a dwelling place of jackals, a desolation forever. No man will dwell there, neither will any son of man live therein.” ³⁴The LORD’s word that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning Elam, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, saying, ³⁵“The LORD of Hosts says: ‘Behold, I will break the bow of Elam, the chief of their might. ³⁶I will bring on Elam the four winds from the four quarters of the sky, and will scatter them toward all those winds. There will be no nation where the outcasts of Elam will not come. ³⁷I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies, and before those who seek their life. I will bring evil on them, even my fierce anger,’ says the LORD; ‘and I will send the sword after them, until I have consumed them. ³⁸I will set my throne in Elam, and will destroy from there king and princes,’ says the LORD. ³⁹‘But it will happen in the latter days that I will reverse the captivity of Elam,’ says the LORD.”

50The word that the LORD spoke concerning Babylon, concerning the land of the Kasdim, by Jeremiah the prophet. ²“Declare among the nations and publish, and set up a standard; publish, and don’t conceal; say, ‘Babylon has been taken, Bel is disappointed, Merodach is dismayed! Her images are disappointed. Her idols are dismayed.’ ³For a nation comes up out of the north against her, which will make her land desolate, and no one will dwell in it. They have fled. They are gone, both man and animal. ⁴“In those days, and in that time,” says the LORD, “the children of Israel will come, they and the children of Judah together; they will go on their way weeping, and will seek

the LORD their God. ⁵They will inquire concerning Zion with their faces turned toward it, saying, 'Come, and join yourselves to the LORD in an everlasting covenant that will not be forgotten.' ⁶My people have been lost sheep. Their shepherds have caused them to go astray. They have turned them away on the mountains. They have gone from mountain to hill. They have forgotten their resting place. ⁷All who found them have devoured them. Their adversaries said, 'We are not guilty, because they have sinned against the LORD, the habitation of righteousness, even the LORD, the hope of their fathers.' ⁸'Flee out of the middle of Babylon! Go out of the land of the Kasdim, and be as the male goats before the flocks. ⁹For, behold, I will stir up and cause to come up against Babylon a company of great nations from the north country; and they will set themselves in array against her. She will be taken from there. Their arrows will be as of an expert mighty man. None of them will return in vain. ¹⁰Kasdim will be a prey. All who prey on her will be satisfied,' says the LORD. ¹¹'Because you are glad, because you rejoice, O you who plunder my heritage, because you are wanton as a heifer that treads out the grain, and neigh as strong horses, ¹²your mother will be utterly disappointed. She who bore you will be confounded. Behold, she will be the least of the nations, a wilderness, a dry land, and a desert. ¹³Because of the LORD's wrath she won't be inhabited, but she will be wholly desolate. Everyone who goes by Babylon will be astonished, and hiss at all her plagues. ¹⁴Set yourselves in array against Babylon all around, all you who bend the bow; shoot at her. Spare no arrows, for she has sinned against the LORD. ¹⁵Shout against her all around. She has submitted herself. Her bulwarks have fallen. Her walls have been thrown down, for it is the vengeance of the LORD. Take vengeance on her. As she has done, do to her. ¹⁶Cut off the sower from Babylon, and him who handles the sickle in the time of harvest. For fear of the oppressing sword, they will each return to their own people, and they will each flee to their own land. ¹⁷'Israel is a hunted sheep. The lions have driven him away. First, the king of Assyria devoured him, and now at last Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon has broken his bones.' ¹⁸Therefore the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will punish the king of Babylon and his land, as I have punished the king of Assyria. ¹⁹I will bring Israel again to his pasture, and he will feed on Carmel and Bashan. His soul will be satisfied on the hills of Ephraim and in Gilead. ²⁰In those days, and in that time,' says the LORD, 'the iniquity of Israel will be sought for, and there will be none, also the sins of Judah, and they won't be found; for I will pardon them whom I leave as a remnant. ²¹'Go up against the land of Merathaim, even against it, and against the inhabitants of Pekod. Kill and utterly destroy after them,' says the LORD, 'and do according to all that I have commanded you. ²²A sound of battle is in the land, and of great de-

struction. ²³How the hammer of the whole earth is cut apart and broken! How Babylon has become a desolation among the nations! ²⁴I have laid a snare for you, and you are also taken, Babylon, and you weren't aware. You are found, and also caught, because you have fought against the LORD. ²⁵The LORD has opened his armory, and has brought out the weapons of his indignation; for the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, has a work to do in the land of the Kasdim. ²⁶Come against her from the farthest border. Open her storehouses. Cast her up as heaps. Destroy her utterly. Let nothing of her be left. ²⁷Kill all her bulls. Let them go down to the slaughter. Woe to them! For their day has come, the time of their visitation. ²⁸Listen to those who flee and escape out of the land of Babylon, to declare in Zion the vengeance of the LORD our God, the vengeance of his temple. ²⁹'Call together the archers against Babylon, all those who bend the bow. Encamp against her all around. Let none of it escape. Pay her back according to her work. According to all that she has done, do to her; for she has been proud against the LORD, against the Holy One of Israel. ³⁰Therefore her young men will fall in her streets. All her men of war will be brought to silence in that day,' says the LORD. ³¹'Behold, I am against you, you proud one,' says the Lord, the LORD of Hosts; 'for your day has come, the time that I will visit you. ³²The proud one will stumble and fall, and no one will raise him up. I will kindle a fire in his cities, and it will devour all who are around him.' ³³The LORD of Hosts says: 'The children of Israel and the children of Judah are oppressed together. All who took them captive hold them fast. They refuse to let them go. ³⁴Their Redeemer is strong. The LORD of Hosts is his name. He will thoroughly plead their cause, that he may give rest to the earth, and disquiet the inhabitants of Babylon. ³⁵'A sword is on the Kasdim,' says the LORD, 'and on the inhabitants of Babylon, on her princes, and on her wise men. ³⁶A sword is on the boasters, and they will become fools. A sword is on her mighty men, and they will be dismayed. ³⁷A sword is on their horses, on their chariots, and on all the mixed people who are in the middle of her; and they will become as women. A sword is on her treasures, and they will be robbed. ³⁸A drought is on her waters, and they will be dried up; for it is a land of engraved images, and they are mad over idols. ³⁹Therefore the wild animals of the desert with the wolves will dwell there. The ostriches will dwell therein. It will be inhabited no more forever, neither will it be lived in from generation to generation. ⁴⁰As when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah and its neighbor cities,' says the LORD, 'so no man will dwell there, neither will any son of man live therein. ⁴¹'Behold, a people comes from the north. A great nation and many kings will be stirred up from the uttermost parts of the earth. ⁴²They take up bow and spear. They are cruel, and have no mercy. Their voice roars like the sea. They ride on horses, ev-

everyone set in array, as a man to the battle, against you, daughter of Babylon. ⁴³The king of Babylon has heard the news of them, and his hands become feeble. Anguish has taken hold of him, pains as of a woman in labor. ⁴⁴Behold, the enemy will come up like a lion from the thickets of the Jordan against the strong habitation; for I will suddenly make them run away from it. Whoever is chosen, I will appoint him over it, for who is like me? Who will appoint me a time? Who is the shepherd who can stand before me?" ⁴⁵Therefore hear the counsel of the LORD that he has taken against Babylon; and his purposes that he has purposed against the land of the Kasdim: Surely they will drag them away, even the little ones of the flock. Surely he will make their habitation desolate over them. ⁴⁶The earth trembles at the noise of the taking of Babylon. The cry is heard among the nations.

51The LORD says: "Behold, I will raise up against Babylon, and against those who dwell in Lebkamai, a destroying wind. ²I will send to Babylon strangers, who will winnow her. They will empty her land; for in the day of trouble they will be against her all around. ³Against him who bends, let the archer bend his bow, also against him who lifts himself up in his coat of mail. Don't spare her young men! Utterly destroy all her army! ⁴They will fall down slain in the land of the Kasdim, and thrust through in her streets. ⁵For Israel is not forsaken, nor Judah, by his God, by the LORD of Hosts; though their land is full of guilt against the Holy One of Israel. ⁶"Flee out of the middle of Babylon! Everyone save his own life! Don't be cut off in her iniquity, for it is the time of the LORD's vengeance. He will render to her a recompense. ⁷Babylon has been a golden cup in the LORD's hand, who made all the earth drunk. The nations have drunk of her wine; therefore the nations have gone mad. ⁸Babylon has suddenly fallen and been destroyed! Wail for her! Take balm for her pain. Perhaps she may be healed. ⁹"We would have healed Babylon, but she is not healed. Forsake her, and let's each go into his own country; for her judgment reaches to heaven, and is lifted up even to the skies. ¹⁰"The LORD has produced our righteousness. Come, and let's declare in Zion the work of the LORD our God.' ¹¹"Make the arrows sharp! Hold the shields firmly! The LORD has stirred up the spirit of the kings of the Medes, because his purpose is against Babylon, to destroy it; for it is the vengeance of the LORD, the vengeance of his temple. ¹²Set up a standard against the walls of Babylon! Make the watch strong! Set the watchmen, and prepare the ambushes; for the LORD has both purposed and done that which he spoke concerning the inhabitants of Babylon. ¹³You who dwell on many waters, abundant in treasures, your end has come, the measure of your covetousness. ¹⁴The LORD of Hosts has sworn by himself, saying, 'Surely I will fill you with men, as with locusts, and they will lift up a shout

against you.' ¹⁵"He has made the earth by his power. He has established the world by his wisdom. By his understanding he has stretched out the heavens. ¹⁶When he utters his voice, there is a roar of waters in the heavens, and he causes the vapors to ascend from the ends of the earth. He makes lightning for the rain, and brings the wind out of his treasures. ¹⁷"Every man has become stupid and without knowledge. Every goldsmith is disappointed by his image, for his molten images are falsehood, and there is no breath in them. ¹⁸They are vanity, a work of delusion. In the time of their visitation, they will perish. ¹⁹The portion of Jacob is not like these, for he formed all things, including the tribe of his inheritance. The LORD of Hosts is his name. ²⁰"You are my battle ax and weapons of war. With you I will break the nations into pieces. With you I will destroy kingdoms. ²¹With you I will break in pieces the horse and his rider. ²²With you I will break in pieces the chariot and him who rides therein. With you I will break in pieces man and woman. With you I will break in pieces the old man and the youth. With you I will break in pieces the young man and the virgin. ²³With you I will break in pieces the shepherd and his flock. With you I will break in pieces the farmer and his yoke. With you I will break in pieces governors and deputies. ²⁴"I will render to Babylon and to all the inhabitants of the Kasdim for all their evil that they have done in Zion in your sight," says the LORD. ²⁵"Behold, I am against you, destroying mountain," says the LORD, "which destroys all the earth. I will stretch out my hand on you, roll you down from the rocks, and will make you a burned mountain. ²⁶They won't take a cornerstone from you, nor a stone for foundations; but you will be desolate forever," says the LORD. ²⁷"Set up a standard in the land! Blow the shofar among the nations! Prepare the nations against her! Call together against her the kingdoms of Ararat, Minni, and Ashkenaz! Appoint a marshal against her! Cause the horses to come up as the swarming locusts! ²⁸Prepare against her the nations, the kings of the Medes, its governors, and all its deputies, and all the land of their dominion! ²⁹The land trembles and is in pain; for the purposes of the LORD against Babylon stand, to make the land of Babylon a desolation, without inhabitant. ³⁰The mighty men of Babylon have stopped fighting, they remain in their strongholds. Their might has failed. They have become as women. Her dwelling places are set on fire. Her bars are broken. ³¹One runner will run to meet another, and one messenger to meet another, to show the king of Babylon that his city is taken on every quarter. ³²So the passages are seized. They have burned the reeds with fire. The men of war are frightened." ³³For the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel says: "The daughter of Babylon is like a threshing floor at the time when it is trodden. Yet a little while, and the time of harvest comes for her." ³⁴"Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon has devoured me. He has crushed me. He has made me

an empty vessel. He has, like a monster, swallowed me up. He has filled his mouth with my delicacies. He has cast me out. ³⁵May the violence done to me and to my flesh be on Babylon!" the inhabitant of Zion will say; and, "May my blood be on the inhabitants of Kasdim!" will Jerusalem say. ³⁶Therefore the LORD says: "Behold, I will plead your cause, and take vengeance for you. I will dry up her sea, and make her fountain dry. ³⁷Babylon will become heaps, a dwelling place for jackals, an astonishment, and a hissing, without inhabitant. ³⁸They will roar together like young lions. They will growl as lions' cubs. ³⁹When they are inflamed, I will make their feast, and I will make them drunk, that they may rejoice, and sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake up," says the LORD. ⁴⁰"I will bring them down like lambs to the slaughter, like rams with male goats. ⁴¹"How Sheshach is taken! How the praise of the whole earth is seized! How Babylon has become a desolation among the nations! ⁴²The sea has come up on Babylon. She is covered with the multitude of its waves. ⁴³Her cities have become a desolation, a dry land, and a desert, a land in which no man dwells. No son of man passes by it. ⁴⁴I will execute judgment on Bel in Babylon, and I will bring out of his mouth that which he has swallowed up. The nations will not flow any more to him. Yes, the wall of Babylon will fall. ⁴⁵"My people, go away from the middle of her, and each of you save yourselves from the LORD's fierce anger. ⁴⁶Don't let your heart faint. Don't fear for the news that will be heard in the land. For news will come one year, and after that in another year news will come, and violence in the land, ruler against ruler. ⁴⁷Therefore behold, the days come that I will execute judgment on the engraved images of Babylon; and her whole land will be confounded. All her slain will fall in the middle of her. ⁴⁸Then the heavens and the earth, and all that is therein, will sing for joy over Babylon; for the destroyers will come to her from the north," says the LORD. ⁴⁹"As Babylon has caused the slain of Israel to fall, so the slain of all the land will fall at Babylon. ⁵⁰You who have escaped the sword, go! Don't stand still! Remember the LORD from afar, and let Jerusalem come into your mind." ⁵¹"We are confounded because we have heard reproach. Confusion has covered our faces, for strangers have come into the sanctuaries of the LORD's house." ⁵²"Therefore behold, the days come," says the LORD, "that I will execute judgment on her engraved images; and through all her land the wounded will groan. ⁵³Though Babylon should mount up to the sky, and though she should fortify the height of her strength, yet destroyers will come to her from me," says the LORD. ⁵⁴"The sound of a cry comes from Babylon, and of great destruction from the land of the Kasdim! ⁵⁵For the LORD lays Babylon waste, and destroys out of her the great voice! Their waves roar like many waters. The noise of their voice is uttered. ⁵⁶For the destroyer has come on her, even on Babylon. Her mighty men are taken. Their bows are bro-

ken in pieces, for the LORD is a God of retribution. He will surely repay. ⁵⁷I will make her princes, her wise men, her governors, her deputies, and her mighty men drunk. They will sleep a perpetual sleep, and not wake up," says the King, whose name is the LORD of Hosts. ⁵⁸The LORD of Hosts says: "The wide walls of Babylon will be utterly overthrown. Her high gates will be burned with fire. The peoples will labor for vanity, and the nations for the fire; and they will be weary." ⁵⁹The word which Jeremiah the prophet commanded Seraiah the son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, when he went with Zedekiah the king of Judah to Babylon in the fourth year of his reign. Now Seraiah was chief quartermaster. ⁶⁰Jeremiah wrote in a book all the evil that should come on Babylon, even all these words that are written concerning Babylon. ⁶¹Jeremiah said to Seraiah, "When you come to Babylon, then see that you read all these words, ⁶²and say, 'LORD, you have spoken concerning this place, to cut it off, that no one will dwell in it, neither man nor animal, but that it will be desolate forever.' ⁶³It will be, when you have finished reading this book, that you shall bind a stone to it, and cast it into the middle of the Euphrates. ⁶⁴Then you shall say, 'Thus will Babylon sink, and will not rise again because of the evil that I will bring on her; and they will be weary.'" Thus far are the words of Jeremiah.

52Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah. ²He did that which was evil in the LORD's sight, according to all that Jehoiakim had done. ³For through the LORD's anger this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence. Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon. ⁴In the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and encamped against it; and they built forts against it round about. ⁵So the city was besieged to the eleventh year of King Zedekiah. ⁶In the fourth month, in the ninth day of the month, the famine was severe in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land. ⁷Then a breach was made in the city, and all the men of war fled, and went out of the city by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden. Now the Kasdim were against the city all around. The men of war went toward the Arabah, ⁸but the army of the Kasdim pursued the king, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him. ⁹Then they took the king, and carried him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath; and he pronounced judgment on him. ¹⁰The king of Babylon killed the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes. He also killed all the princes of Judah in Riblah. ¹¹He put out the eyes of Zedekiah; and the king of Babylon bound him in fetters,

and carried him to Babylon, and put him in prison until the day of his death. ¹²Now in the fifth month, in the tenth day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard, who stood before the king of Babylon, came into Jerusalem. ¹³He burned the LORD's house, and the king's house; and all the houses of Jerusalem, even every great house, he burned with fire. ¹⁴All the army of the Kasdim, who were with the captain of the guard, broke down all the walls of Jerusalem all around. ¹⁵Then Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the poorest of the people, and the rest of the people who were left in the city, and those who fell away, who defected to the king of Babylon, and the rest of the multitude. ¹⁶But Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard left of the poorest of the land to be vineyard keepers and farmers. ¹⁷The Kasdim broke the pillars of bronze that were in the LORD's house and the bases and the bronze sea that were in the LORD's house in pieces, and carried all of their bronze to Babylon. ¹⁸They also took away the pots, the shovels, the snuffers, the basins, the spoons, and all the vessels of bronze with which they ministered. ¹⁹The captain of the guard took away the cups, the fire pans, the basins, the pots, the lamp stands, the spoons, and the bowls; that which was of gold, as gold, and that which was of silver, as silver. ²⁰They took the two pillars, the one sea, and the twelve bronze bulls that were under the bases, which King Solomon had made for the LORD's house. The bronze of all these vessels was without weight. ²¹As for the pillars, the height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits; ^x and a line of twelve cubits encircled it; and its thickness was four fingers. It was hollow. ²²A capital of bronze was on it; and the height of the one capital was five cubits, ^{xi} with network and pomegranates on the capital all around, all of bronze. The second pillar also had the same, with pomegranates. ²³There were ninety-six pomegranates on the sides; all the pomegranates were one hundred on the network all around. ²⁴The captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the threshold, ²⁵and out of the city he took an officer who was set over the men of war; and seven men of those who saw the king's face, who were found in the city; and the scribe of the captain of the army, who mustered the people of the land; and sixty men of the people of the land, who were found in the middle of the city. ²⁶Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard took them, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah. ²⁷The king of Babylon struck them, and put them to death at Riblah in the land of Hamath. So Judah was carried away captive out of his land. ²⁸This is

the number of the people whom Nebuchadnezzar carried away captive: in the seventh year, three thousand twenty-three Jews; ²⁹in the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar, he carried away captive from Jerusalem eight hundred thirty-two persons; ³⁰in the twenty-third year of Nebuchadnezzar, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the Jews seven hundred forty-five people. All the people numbered four thousand six hundred. ³¹In the thirty-seventh year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, in the twenty-fifth day of the month, Evilmerodach king of Babylon, in the first year of his reign, lifted up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah, and released him from prison. ³²He spoke kindly to him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings who were with him in Babylon, ³³and changed his prison garments. Jehoiachin ate bread before him continually all the days of his life. ³⁴For his allowance, there was a continual allowance given him by the king of Babylon, every day a portion until the day of his death, all the days of his life.

^xA cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^{xi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Lamentations

¹How the city sits solitary, that was full of people! She has become as a widow, who was great among the nations! She who was a princess among the provinces has become a slave! ²She weeps bitterly in the night. Her tears are on her cheeks. Among all her lovers she has no one to comfort her. All her friends have dealt treacherously with her. They have become her enemies. ³Judah has gone into captivity because of affliction and because of great servitude. She dwells among the nations. She finds no rest. All her persecutors overtook her in her distress. ⁴The roads to Zion mourn, because no one comes to the solemn assembly. All her gates are desolate. Her priests sigh. Her virgins are afflicted, and she herself is in bitterness. ⁵Her adversaries have become the head. Her enemies prosper; for the LORD ⁱ has afflicted her for the multitude of her transgressions. Her young children have gone into captivity before the adversary. ⁶All majesty has departed from the daughter of Zion. Her princes have become like deer that find no pasture. They have gone without strength before the pursuer. ⁷Jerusalem remembers in the days of her affliction and of her miseries all her pleasant things that were from the days of old; when her people fell into the hand of the adversary, and no one helped her. The adversaries saw her. They mocked at her desolations. ⁸Jerusalem has grievously sinned. Therefore she has become unclean. All who honored her despise her, because they have seen her nakedness. Yes, she sighs and turns backward. ⁹Her filthiness was in her skirts. She didn't remember her latter end. Therefore she has come down astoundingly. She has no comforter. "See, LORD, my affliction; for the enemy has magnified himself." ¹⁰The adversary has spread out his hand on all her pleasant things; for she has seen that the nations have entered into her sanctuary, concerning whom you commanded that they should not enter into your assembly. ¹¹All her people sigh. They seek bread. They have given their pleasant things for food to refresh their soul. "Look, LORD, and see, for I have become despised." ¹²"Is it nothing to you, all you who pass by? Look, and see if there is any sorrow like my sorrow, which is brought on me, with which the LORD has afflicted me in the day

of his fierce anger. ¹³"From on high has he sent fire into my bones, and it prevails against them. He has spread a net for my feet. He has turned me back. He has made me desolate and I faint all day long. ¹⁴"The yoke of my transgressions is bound by his hand. They are knit together. They have come up on my neck. He made my strength fail. The Lord ⁱⁱ has delivered me into their hands, against whom I am not able to stand. ¹⁵"The Lord has set at nothing all my mighty men within me. He has called a solemn assembly against me to crush my young men. The Lord has trodden the virgin daughter of Judah as in a wine press. ¹⁶"For these things I weep. My eye, my eye runs down with water, because the comforter who should refresh my soul is far from me. My children are desolate, because the enemy has prevailed." ¹⁷Zion spreads out her hands. There is no one to comfort her. The LORD has commanded concerning Jacob, that those who are around him should be his adversaries. Jerusalem is among them as an unclean thing. ¹⁸"The LORD is righteous, for I have rebelled against his commandment. Please hear all you peoples, and see my sorrow. My virgins and my young men have gone into captivity. ¹⁹"I called for my lovers, but they deceived me. My priests and my elders gave up the spirit in the city, while they sought food for themselves to refresh their souls. ²⁰"Look, LORD; for I am in distress. My heart is troubled. My heart turns over within me, for I have grievously rebelled. Abroad, the sword bereaves. At home, it is like death. ²¹"They have heard that I sigh. There is no one to comfort me. All my enemies have heard of my trouble. They are glad that you have done it. You will bring the day that you have proclaimed, and they will be like me. ²²"Let all their wickedness come before you. Do to them as you have done to me for all my transgressions. For my sighs are many, and my heart is faint.

²How has the Lord covered the daughter of Zion with a cloud in his anger! He has cast the beauty of Israel down from heaven to the earth, and hasn't remembered his footstool in the day of his anger. ²The Lord has swallowed up all the dwellings of Jacob without pity. He has thrown down in his wrath the strongholds of the daughter of Ju-

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

dah. He has brought them down to the ground. He has profaned the kingdom and its princes. ³He has cut off all the horn of Israel in fierce anger. He has drawn back his right hand from before the enemy. He has burned up Jacob like a flaming fire, which devours all around. ⁴He has bent his bow like an enemy. He has stood with his right hand as an adversary. He has killed all that were pleasant to the eye. In the tent of the daughter of Zion, he has poured out his wrath like fire. ⁵The Lord has become as an enemy. He has swallowed up Israel. He has swallowed up all her palaces. He has destroyed his strongholds. He has multiplied mourning and lamentation in the daughter of Judah. ⁶He has violently taken away his tabernacle, as if it were a garden. He has destroyed his place of assembly. The LORD has caused solemn assembly and Sabbath to be forgotten in Zion. In the indignation of his anger, he has despised the king and the priest. ⁷The Lord has cast off his altar. He has abhorred his sanctuary. He has given the walls of her palaces into the hand of the enemy. They have made a noise in the LORD's house, as in the day of a solemn assembly. ⁸The LORD has purposed to destroy the wall of the daughter of Zion. He has stretched out the line. He has not withdrawn his hand from destroying; He has made the rampart and wall lament. They languish together. ⁹Her gates have sunk into the ground. He has destroyed and broken her bars. Her king and her princes are among the nations where the law is not. Yes, her prophets find no vision from the LORD. ¹⁰The elders of the daughter of Zion sit on the ground. They keep silence. They have cast up dust on their heads. They have clothed themselves with sackcloth. The virgins of Jerusalem hang down their heads to the ground. ¹¹My eyes fail with tears. My heart is troubled. My bile is poured on the earth, because of the destruction of the daughter of my people, because the young children and the infants swoon in the streets of the city. ¹²They ask their mothers, "Where is grain and wine?" when they swoon as the wounded in the streets of the city, when their soul is poured out into their mothers' bosom. ¹³What shall I testify to you? What shall I liken to you, daughter of Jerusalem? What shall I compare to you, that I may comfort you, virgin daughter of Zion? For your breach is as big as the sea. Who can heal you? ¹⁴Your prophets have seen false and foolish visions for you. They have not uncovered your iniquity, to reverse your captivity, but have seen for you false revelations and causes of banishment. ¹⁵All that pass by clap their hands at you. They hiss and wag their head at the daughter of Jerusalem, saying, "Is this the city that men called 'The perfection of beauty, the joy of the whole earth'?" ¹⁶All your enemies have opened their mouth wide against you. They hiss and gnash their teeth. They say, "We have swallowed her up. Certainly this is the day that we looked for. We have found it. We have seen it." ¹⁷The LORD has done that which he planned. He has fulfilled his word that he

commanded in the days of old. He has thrown down, and has not pitied. He has caused the enemy to rejoice over you. He has exalted the horn of your adversaries. ¹⁸Their heart cried to the Lord. O wall of the daughter of Zion, let tears run down like a river day and night. Give yourself no relief. Don't let your eyes rest. ¹⁹Arise, cry out in the night, at the beginning of the watches! Pour out your heart like water before the face of the Lord. Lift up your hands toward him for the life of your young children, who faint for hunger at the head of every street. ²⁰"Look, LORD, and see to whom you have done thus! Should the women eat their offspring, the children that they held and bounced on their knees? Should the priest and the prophet be killed in the sanctuary of the Lord? ²¹"The youth and the old man lie on the ground in the streets. My virgins and my young men have fallen by the sword. You have killed them in the day of your anger. You have slaughtered, and not pitied. ²²"You have called, as in the day of a solemn assembly, my terrors on every side. There was no one that escaped or remained in the day of the LORD's anger. My enemy has consumed those whom I have cared for and brought up.

3I am the man who has seen affliction by the rod of his wrath. ²He has led me and caused me to walk in darkness, and not in light. ³Surely he turns his hand against me again and again all day long. ⁴He has made my flesh and my skin old. He has broken my bones. ⁵He has built against me, and surrounded me with bitterness and hardship. ⁶He has made me dwell in dark places, as those who have been long dead. ⁷He has walled me about, so that I can't go out. He has made my chain heavy. ⁸Yes, when I cry, and call for help, he shuts out my prayer. ⁹He has walled up my ways with cut stone. He has made my paths crooked. ¹⁰He is to me as a bear lying in wait, as a lion in hiding. ¹¹He has turned away my path, and pulled me in pieces. He has made me desolate. ¹²He has bent his bow, and set me as a mark for the arrow. ¹³He has caused the shafts of his quiver to enter into my kidneys. ¹⁴I have become a derision to all my people, and their song all day long. ¹⁵He has filled me with bitterness. He has stuffed me with wormwood. ¹⁶He has also broken my teeth with gravel. He has covered me with ashes. ¹⁷You have removed my soul far away from peace. I forgot prosperity. ¹⁸I said, "My strength has perished, along with my expectation from the LORD." ¹⁹Remember my affliction and my misery, the wormwood and the bitterness. ²⁰My soul still remembers them, and is bowed down within me. ²¹This I recall to my mind; therefore I have hope. ²²It is because of The LORD's loving kindnesses that we are not consumed, because his mercies don't fail. ²³They are new every morning. Great is your faithfulness. ²⁴"The LORD is my portion," says my soul. "Therefore I will hope in him." ²⁵The LORD is good to those who wait for him, to

the soul who seeks him. ²⁶It is good that a man should hope and quietly wait for the salvation of the LORD. ²⁷It is good for a man that he bear the yoke in his youth. ²⁸Let him sit alone and keep silence, because he has laid it on him. ²⁹Let him put his mouth in the dust, if it is so that there may be hope. ³⁰Let him give his cheek to him who strikes him. Let him be filled full of reproach. ³¹For the Lord will not cast off forever. ³²For though he causes grief, yet he will have compassion according to the multitude of his loving kindnesses. ³³For he does not afflict willingly, nor grieve the children of men. ³⁴To crush under foot all the prisoners of the earth, ³⁵to turn away the right of a man before the face of the Most High, ³⁶to subvert a man in his cause, the Lord doesn't approve. ³⁷Who is he who says, and it comes to pass, when the Lord doesn't command it? ³⁸Doesn't evil and good come out of the mouth of the Most High? ³⁹Why should a living man complain, a man for the punishment of his sins? ⁴⁰Let us search and try our ways, and turn again to the LORD. ⁴¹Let's lift up our heart with our hands to God ⁱⁱⁱ in the heavens. ⁴²"We have transgressed and have rebelled. You have not pardoned. ⁴³"You have covered us with anger and pursued us. You have killed. You have not pitied. ⁴⁴You have covered yourself with a cloud, so that no prayer can pass through. ⁴⁵You have made us an off-scouring and refuse in the middle of the peoples. ⁴⁶"All our enemies have opened their mouth wide against us. ⁴⁷Terror and the pit have come on us, devastation and destruction." ⁴⁸My eye runs down with streams of water, for the destruction of the daughter of my people. ⁴⁹My eye pours down and doesn't cease, without any intermission, ⁵⁰until the LORD looks down, and sees from heaven. ⁵¹My eye affects my soul, because of all the daughters of my city. ⁵²They have chased me relentlessly like a bird, those who are my enemies without cause. ⁵³They have cut off my life in the dungeon, and have cast a stone on me. ⁵⁴Waters flowed over my head. I said, "I am cut off." ⁵⁵I called on your name, LORD, out of the lowest dungeon. ⁵⁶You heard my voice: "Don't hide your ear from my sighing, and my cry." ⁵⁷You came near in the day that I called on you. You said, "Don't be afraid." ⁵⁸Lord, you have pleaded the causes of my soul. You have redeemed my life. ⁵⁹LORD, you have seen my wrong. Judge my cause. ⁶⁰You have seen all their vengeance and all their plans against me. ⁶¹You have heard their reproach, LORD, and all their plans against me, ⁶²the lips of those that rose up against me, and their plots against me all day long. ⁶³You see their sitting down and their rising up. I am their song. ⁶⁴You will pay them back, LORD, according to the work of their hands. ⁶⁵You will give them hardness of heart, your curse to them. ⁶⁶You will pursue them in anger, and destroy them from under the heavens of the LORD.

4How the gold has become dim! The most pure gold has

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

changed! The stones of the sanctuary are poured out at the head of every street. ²The precious sons of Zion, comparable to fine gold, how they are esteemed as earthen pitchers, the work of the hands of the potter! ³Even the jackals offer their breast. They nurse their young ones. But the daughter of my people has become cruel, like the ostriches in the wilderness. ⁴The tongue of the nursing child clings to the roof of his mouth for thirst. The young children ask bread, and no one breaks it for them. ⁵Those who ate delicacies are desolate in the streets. Those who were brought up in purple embrace dunghills. ⁶For the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the sin of Sodom, which was overthrown as in a moment. No hands were laid on her. ⁷Her Nazirites were purer than snow. They were whiter than milk. They were more ruddy in body than rubies. Their polishing was like sapphire. ⁸Their appearance is blacker than a coal. They are not known in the streets. Their skin clings to their bones. It is withered. It has become like wood. ⁹Those who are killed with the sword are better than those who are killed with hunger; for these pine away, stricken through, for lack of the fruits of the field. ¹⁰The hands of the pitiful women have boiled their own children. They were their food in the destruction of the daughter of my people. ¹¹The LORD has accomplished his wrath. He has poured out his fierce anger. He has kindled a fire in Zion, which has devoured its foundations. ¹²The kings of the earth didn't believe, neither did all the inhabitants of the world, that the adversary and the enemy would enter into the gates of Jerusalem. ¹³It is because of the sins of her prophets and the iniquities of her priests, that have shed the blood of the just in the middle of her. ¹⁴They wander as blind men in the streets. They are polluted with blood, So that men can't touch their garments. ¹⁵"Go away!" they cried to them. "Unclean! Go away! Go away! Don't touch! When they fled away and wandered, men said among the nations, "They can't live here any more." ¹⁶The LORD's anger has scattered them. He will not pay attention to them any more. They didn't respect the persons of the priests. They didn't favor the elders. ¹⁷Our eyes still fail, looking in vain for our help. In our watching we have watched for a nation that could not save. ¹⁸They hunt our steps, so that we can't go in our streets. Our end is near. Our days are fulfilled, for our end has come. ¹⁹Our pursuers were swifter than the eagles of the sky. They chased us on the mountains. They set an ambush for us in the wilderness. ²⁰The breath of our nostrils, the anointed of the LORD, was taken in their pits; of whom we said, under his shadow we will live among the nations. ²¹Rejoice and be glad, daughter of Edom, who dwells in the land of Uz. The cup will pass through to you also. You will be drunken, and will make yourself naked. ²²The punishment of your iniquity is accomplished, daughter of Zion. He will no more carry you away into captivity. He will visit your iniquity, daughter of Edom. He will

uncover your sins.

⁵Remember, LORD, what has come on us. Look, and see our reproach. ²Our inheritance has been turned over to strangers, our houses to aliens. ³We are orphans and fatherless. Our mothers are as widows. ⁴We must pay for water to drink. Our wood is sold to us. ⁵Our pursuers are on our necks. We are weary, and have no rest. ⁶We have given our hands to the Egyptians, and to the Assyrians, to be satisfied with bread. ⁷Our fathers sinned, and are no more. We have borne their iniquities. ⁸Servants rule over us. There is no one to deliver us out of their hand. ⁹We get our bread at the peril of our lives, because of the sword in the wilderness. ¹⁰Our skin is black like an oven, because of the burning heat of famine. ¹¹They ravished the women in Zion, the virgins in the cities of Judah. ¹²Princes were hanged up by their hands. The faces of elders were not honored. ¹³The young men carry millstones. The children stumbled under loads of wood. ¹⁴The elders have ceased from the gate, and the young men from their music. ¹⁵The joy of our heart has ceased. Our dance is turned into mourning. ¹⁶The crown has fallen from our head. Woe to us, for we have sinned! ¹⁷For this our heart is faint. For these things our eyes are dim: ¹⁸for the mountain of Zion, which is desolate. The foxes walk on it. ¹⁹You, LORD, remain forever. Your throne is from generation to generation. ²⁰Why do you forget us forever, and forsake us for so long a time? ²¹Turn us to yourself, LORD, and we will be turned. Renew our days as of old. ²²But you have utterly rejected us. You are very angry against us.

Ezekiel

¹Now in the thirtieth year, in the fourth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I was among the captives by the river Chebar, the heavens were opened, and I saw visions of God. ⁱ ²In the fifth of the month, which was the fifth year of King Jehoiachin's captivity, ³the LORD's ⁱⁱ word came to Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, in the land of the Kasdim by the river Chebar; and the LORD's hand was there on him. ⁴I looked, and behold, ⁱⁱⁱ a stormy wind came out of the north: a great cloud, with flashing lightning, and a brightness around it, and out of the middle of it as it were glowing metal, out of the middle of the fire. ⁵Out of its center came the likeness of four living creatures. This was their appearance: They had the likeness of a man. ⁶Everyone had four faces, and each one of them had four wings. ⁷Their feet were straight feet. The sole of their feet was like the sole of a calf's foot; and they sparkled like burnished bronze. ⁸They had the hands of a man under their wings on their four sides. The four of them had their faces and their wings like this: ⁹Their wings were joined to one another. They didn't turn when they went. Each one went straight forward. ¹⁰As for the likeness of their faces, they had the face of a man. The four of them had the face of a lion on the right side. The four of them had the face of an ox on the left side. The four of them also had the face of an eagle. ¹¹Such were their faces. Their wings were spread out above. Two wings of each one touched another, and two covered their bodies. ¹²Each one went straight forward. Where the spirit was to go, they went. They didn't turn when they went. ¹³As for the likeness of the living creatures, their appearance was like burning coals of fire, like the appearance of torches. The fire went up and down among the living creatures. The fire was bright, and lightning went out of the fire. ¹⁴The living creatures ran and returned as the appearance of a flash of lightning. ¹⁵Now as I saw the living creatures, behold, there was one wheel on the earth beside the living creatures, for each of the four faces of it. ¹⁶The appearance of the wheels and their work was like a beryl. The four of them had

one likeness. Their appearance and their work was as it were a wheel within a wheel. ¹⁷When they went, they went in their four directions. They didn't turn when they went. ¹⁸As for their rims, they were high and dreadful; and the four of them had their rims full of eyes all around. ¹⁹When the living creatures went, the wheels went beside them. When the living creatures were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up. ²⁰Wherever the spirit was to go, they went. The spirit was to go there. The wheels were lifted up beside them; for the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels. ²¹When those went, these went. When those stood, these stood. When those were lifted up from the earth, the wheels were lifted up beside them; for the spirit of the living creature was in the wheels. ²²Over the head of the living creature there was the likeness of an expanse, like an awesome crystal to look at, stretched out over their heads above. ²³Under the expanse, their wings were straight, one toward the other. Each one had two which covered on this side, and each one had two which covered their bodies on that side. ²⁴When they went, I heard the noise of their wings like the noise of great waters, like the voice of the Almighty, a noise of tumult like the noise of an army. When they stood, they let down their wings. ²⁵There was a voice above the expanse that was over their heads. When they stood, they let down their wings. ²⁶Above the expanse that was over their heads was the likeness of a throne, as the appearance of a sapphire ^{iv} stone. On the likeness of the throne was a likeness as the appearance of a man on it above. ²⁷I saw as it were glowing metal, as the appearance of fire within it all around, from the appearance of his waist and upward; and from the appearance of his waist and downward I saw as it were the appearance of fire, and there was brightness around him. ²⁸As the appearance of the rainbow that is in the cloud in the day of rain, so was the appearance of the brightness all around. This was the appearance of the likeness of the LORD's glory. When I saw it, I fell on my face, and I heard a voice of one that spoke.

²He said to me, "Son of man, stand on your feet, and I will speak with you." ²The Spirit entered into me when

ⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}or, lapis lazuli

he spoke to me, and set me on my feet; and I heard him who spoke to me. ³He said to me, “Son of man, I send you to the children of Israel, to a nation of rebels who have rebelled against me. They and their fathers have transgressed against me even to this very day. ⁴The children are impudent and stiff-hearted. I am sending you to them, and you shall tell them, ‘This is what the Lord ^v GOD says.’ ⁵They, whether they will hear, or whether they will refuse—for they are a rebellious house—yet they will know that there has been a prophet among them. ⁶You, son of man, don’t be afraid of them, neither be afraid of their words, though briars and thorns are with you, and you dwell among scorpions. Don’t be afraid of their words, nor be dismayed at their looks, though they are a rebellious house. ⁷You shall speak my words to them, whether they will hear or whether they will refuse; for they are most rebellious. ⁸But you, son of man, hear what I tell you. Don’t be rebellious like that rebellious house. Open your mouth, and eat that which I give you.” ⁹When I looked, behold, a hand was stretched out to me; and behold, a scroll of a book was in it. ¹⁰He spread it before me. It was written within and without; and lamentations, mourning, and woe were written in it.

³He said to me, “Son of man, eat what you find. Eat this scroll, and go, speak to the house of Israel.” ²So I opened my mouth, and he caused me to eat the scroll. ³He said to me, “Son of man, eat this scroll that I give you and fill your belly and your bowels with it.” Then I ate it. It was as sweet as honey in my mouth. ⁴He said to me, “Son of man, go to the house of Israel, and speak my words to them. ⁵For you are not sent to a people of a strange speech and of a hard language, but to the house of Israel—⁶not to many peoples of a strange speech and of a hard language, whose words you can’t understand. Surely, if I sent you to them, they would listen to you. ⁷But the house of Israel will not listen to you, for they will not listen to me; for all the house of Israel are obstinate ^{vi} and hard-hearted. ⁸Behold, I have made your face hard against their faces, and your forehead hard against their foreheads. ⁹I have made your forehead as a diamond, harder than flint. Don’t be afraid of them, neither be dismayed at their looks, though they are a rebellious house.” ¹⁰Moreover he said to me, “Son of man, receive in your heart and hear with your ears all my words that I speak to you. ¹¹Go to them of the captivity, to the children of your people, and speak to them, and tell them, ‘This is what the Lord GOD says,’ whether they will hear, or whether they will refuse.” ¹²Then the Spirit lifted me up, and I heard behind me the voice of a great rushing, saying, “Blessed be the LORD’s glory from his place.” ¹³I heard the noise of the wings of the living creatures as they touched one another, and the noise of the

wheels beside them, even the noise of a great rushing. ¹⁴So the Spirit lifted me up, and took me away; and I went in bitterness, in the heat of my spirit; and the LORD’s hand was strong on me. ¹⁵Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel Aviv who lived by the river Chebar, and to where they lived; and I sat there overwhelmed among them seven days. ¹⁶At the end of seven days, the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ¹⁷“Son of man, I have made you a watchman to the house of Israel. Therefore hear the word from my mouth, and warn them from me. ¹⁸When I tell the wicked, ‘You will surely die;’ and you give him no warning, nor speak to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life, that wicked man will die in his iniquity; but I will require his blood at your hand. ¹⁹Yet if you warn the wicked, and he doesn’t turn from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he will die in his iniquity; but you have delivered your soul.” ²⁰“Again, when a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, and I lay a stumbling block before him, he will die. Because you have not given him warning, he will die in his sin, and his righteous deeds which he has done will not be remembered; but I will require his blood at your hand. ²¹Nevertheless if you warn the righteous man, that the righteous not sin, and he does not sin, he will surely live, because he took warning; and you have delivered your soul.” ²²the LORD’s hand was there on me; and he said to me, “Arise, go out into the plain, and I will talk with you there.” ²³Then I arose, and went out into the plain, and behold, the LORD’s glory stood there, like the glory which I saw by the river Chebar. Then I fell on my face. ²⁴Then the Spirit entered into me and set me on my feet. He spoke with me, and said to me, “Go, shut yourself inside your house. ²⁵But you, son of man, behold, they will put ropes on you, and will bind you with them, and you will not go out among them. ²⁶I will make your tongue stick to the roof of your mouth so that you will be mute and will not be able to correct them, for they are a rebellious house. ²⁷But when I speak with you, I will open your mouth, and you shall tell them, ‘This is what the Lord GOD says.’ He who hears, let him hear; and he who refuses, let him refuse; for they are a rebellious house.”

⁴“You also, son of man, take a tile, and lay it before yourself, and portray on it a city, even Jerusalem. ²Lay siege against it, build forts against it, and cast up a mound against it. Also set camps against it and plant battering rams against it all around. ³Take for yourself an iron pan and set it for a wall of iron between you and the city. Then set your face toward it. It will be besieged, and you shall lay siege against it. This shall be a sign to the house of Israel. ⁴“Moreover lie on your left side, and lay the iniquity of the house of Israel on it. According to the number of the days that you shall lie on it, you shall bear their iniquity. ⁵For I have appointed the years of their

^vThe word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

^{vi}Literally, have a hard forehead

iniquity to be to you a number of days, even three hundred ninety days. So you shall bear the iniquity of the house of Israel. ⁶“Again, when you have accomplished these, you shall lie on your right side, and shall bear the iniquity of the house of Judah. I have appointed forty days, each day for a year, to you. ⁷You shall set your face toward the siege of Jerusalem, with your arm uncovered; and you shall prophesy against it. ⁸Behold, I put ropes on you, and you shall not turn yourself from one side to the other, until you have accomplished the days of your siege. ⁹“Take for yourself also wheat, barley, beans, lentils, millet, and spelt, and put them in one vessel. Make bread of it. According to the number of the days that you will lie on your side, even three hundred ninety days, you shall eat of it. ¹⁰Your food which you shall eat shall be by weight, twenty shekels ^{vii} a day. From time to time you shall eat it. ¹¹You shall drink water by measure, the sixth part of a hin. ^{viii} From time to time you shall drink. ¹²You shall eat it as barley cakes, and you shall bake it in their sight with dung that comes out of man.” ¹³The LORD said, “Even thus will the children of Israel eat their bread unclean, among the nations where I will drive them.” ¹⁴Then I said, “Ah Lord GOD! Behold, my soul has not been polluted; for from my youth up even until now I have not eaten of that which dies of itself, or is torn of animals. No abominable meat has come into my mouth!” ¹⁵Then he said to me, “Behold, I have given you cow’s dung for man’s dung, and you shall prepare your bread on it.” ¹⁶Moreover he said to me, “Son of man, behold, I will break the staff of bread in Jerusalem. They will eat bread by weight, and with fearfulness. They will drink water by measure, and in dismay; ¹⁷that they may lack bread and water, be dismayed one with another, and pine away in their iniquity.

⁵“You, son of man, take a sharp sword. You shall take it as a barber’s razor to yourself, and shall cause it to pass over your head and over your beard. Then take balances to weigh and divide the hair. ²A third part you shall burn in the fire in the middle of the city, when the days of the siege are fulfilled. You shall take a third part, and strike with the sword around it. A third part you shall scatter to the wind, and I will draw out a sword after them. ³You shall take a small number of these and bind them in the folds of your robe. ⁴Of these again you shall take, and cast them into the middle of the fire, and burn them in the fire. From it a fire will come out into all the house of Israel. ⁵“The Lord GOD says: ‘This is Jerusalem. I have set her in the middle of the nations, and countries are around her. ⁶She has rebelled against my ordinances in doing wickedness more than the nations, and against my statutes more than the countries that are around her; for they have rejected my ordinances, and as for my statutes, they have not walked

in them.’ ⁷“Therefore the Lord GOD says: ‘Because you are more turbulent than the nations that are around you, and have not walked in my statutes, neither have kept my ordinances, neither have followed the ordinances of the nations that are around you; ⁸therefore the Lord GOD says: ‘Behold, I, even I, am against you; and I will execute judgments among you in the sight of the nations. ⁹I will do in you that which I have not done, and which I will not do anything like it any more, because of all your abominations. ¹⁰Therefore the fathers will eat the sons within you, and the sons will eat their fathers. I will execute judgments on you; and I will scatter the whole remnant of you to all the winds. ¹¹Therefore as I live,’ says the Lord GOD, ‘surely, because you have defiled my sanctuary with all your detestable things, and with all your abominations, therefore I will also diminish you. My eye won’t spare, and I will have no pity. ¹²A third part of you will die with the pestilence, and they will be consumed with famine within you. A third part will fall by the sword around you. A third part I will scatter to all the winds, and will draw out a sword after them. ¹³“Thus my anger will be accomplished, and I will cause my wrath toward them to rest, and I will be comforted. They will know that I, the LORD, have spoken in my zeal, when I have accomplished my wrath on them. ¹⁴“Moreover I will make you a desolation and a reproach among the nations that are around you, in the sight of all that pass by. ¹⁵So it will be a reproach and a taunt, an instruction and an astonishment, to the nations that are around you, when I execute judgments on you in anger and in wrath, and in wrathful rebukes—I, the LORD, have spoken it— ¹⁶when I send on them the evil arrows of famine that are for destruction, which I will send to destroy you. I will increase the famine on you and will break your staff of bread. ¹⁷I will send on you famine and evil animals, and they will bereave you. Pestilence and blood will pass through you. I will bring the sword on you. I, the LORD, have spoken it.’”

⁶The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, set your face toward the mountains of Israel, and prophesy to them, ³and say, ‘You mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD! The Lord GOD says to the mountains and to the hills, to the watercourses and to the valleys: “Behold, I, even I, will bring a sword on you, and I will destroy your high places. ⁴Your altars will become desolate, and your incense altars will be broken. I will cast down your slain men before your idols. ⁵I will lay the dead bodies of the children of Israel before their idols. I will scatter your bones around your altars. ⁶In all your dwelling places, the cities will be laid waste and the high places will be desolate, so that your altars may be laid waste and made desolate, and your idols may be broken and cease, and your incense altars may be cut down, and your works may be abolished. ⁷The slain will fall among you, and you will

^{vii}A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{viii}A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

know that I am the LORD. ⁸“Yet I will leave a remnant, in that you will have some that escape the sword among the nations, when you are scattered through the countries. ⁹Those of you that escape will remember me among the nations where they are carried captive, how I have been broken with their lewd heart, which has departed from me, and with their eyes, which play the prostitute after their idols. Then they will loathe themselves in their own sight for the evils which they have committed in all their abominations. ¹⁰They will know that I am the LORD. I have not said in vain that I would do this evil to them.” ¹¹“The Lord GOD says: ‘Strike with your hand, and stamp with your foot, and say, “Alas!” because of all the evil abominations of the house of Israel; for they will fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence. ¹²He who is far off will die of the pestilence. He who is near will fall by the sword. He who remains and is besieged will die by the famine. Thus I will accomplish my wrath on them. ¹³You will know that I am the LORD when their slain men are among their idols around their altars, on every high hill, on all the tops of the mountains, under every green tree, and under every thick oak—the places where they offered pleasant aroma to all their idols. ¹⁴I will stretch out my hand on them and make the land desolate and waste, from the wilderness toward Diblah, throughout all their habitations. Then they will know that I am the LORD.’”

⁷Moreover the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“You, son of man, the Lord GOD says to Eretz-Israel, ‘An end! The end has come on the four corners of the land. ³Now the end is on you, and I will send my anger on you, and will judge you according to your ways. I will bring on you all your abominations. ⁴My eye will not spare you, neither will I have pity; but I will bring your ways on you, and your abominations will be among you. Then you will know that I am the LORD.’ ⁵“The Lord GOD says: ‘A disaster! A unique disaster! Behold, it comes. ⁶An end has come. The end has come! It awakes against you. Behold, it comes. ⁷Your doom has come to you, inhabitant of the land! The time has come! The day is near, a day of tumult, and not of joyful shouting, on the mountains. ⁸Now I will shortly pour out my wrath on you, and accomplish my anger against you, and will judge you according to your ways. I will bring on you all your abominations. ⁹My eye won’t spare, neither will I have pity. I will punish you according to your ways. Your abominations will be among you. Then you will know that I, the LORD, strike. ¹⁰“Behold, the day! Behold, it comes! Your doom has gone out. The rod has blossomed. Pride has budded. ¹¹Violence has risen up into a rod of wickedness. None of them will remain, nor of their multitude, nor of their wealth. There will be nothing of value among them. ¹²The time has come! The day draws near. Don’t let the buyer rejoice, nor the seller mourn; for wrath is on all its multitude.

¹³For the seller won’t return to that which is sold, although they are still alive; for the vision concerns the whole multitude of it. None will return. None will strengthen himself in the iniquity of his life. ¹⁴They have blown the shofar, and have made all ready; but no one goes to the battle, for my wrath is on all its multitude. ¹⁵“The sword is outside, and the pestilence and the famine within. He who is in the field will die by the sword. He who is in the city will be devoured by famine and pestilence. ¹⁶But of those who escape, they will escape and will be on the mountains like doves of the valleys, all of them moaning, everyone in his iniquity. ¹⁷All hands will be feeble, and all knees will be weak as water. ¹⁸They will also clothe themselves with sackcloth, and horror will cover them. Shame will be on all faces, and baldness on all their heads. ¹⁹They will cast their silver in the streets, and their gold will be as an unclean thing. Their silver and their gold won’t be able to deliver them in the day of the LORD’s wrath. They won’t satisfy their souls or fill their bellies; because it has been the stumbling block of their iniquity. ²⁰As for the beauty of his ornament, he set it in majesty; but they made the images of their abominations and their detestable things therein. Therefore I have made it to them as an unclean thing. ²¹I will give it into the hands of the strangers for a prey, and to the wicked of the earth for a plunder; and they will profane it. ²²I will also turn my face from them, and they will profane my secret place. Robbers will enter into it, and profane it. ²³“Make chains, for the land is full of bloody crimes, and the city is full of violence. ²⁴Therefore I will bring the worst of the nations, and they will possess their houses. I will also make the pride of the strong to cease. Their holy places will be profaned. ²⁵Destruction comes! They will seek peace, and there will be none. ²⁶Mischief will come on mischief, and rumor will be on rumor. They will seek a vision of the prophet; but the law will perish from the priest, and counsel from the elders. ²⁷The king will mourn, and the prince will be clothed with desolation. The hands of the people of the land will be troubled. I will do to them after their way, and according to their own judgments I will judge them. Then they will know that I am the LORD.’”

⁸In the sixth year, in the sixth month, in the fifth day of the month, as I sat in my house, and the elders of Judah sat before me, the Lord GOD’s hand fell on me there. ²Then I saw, and behold, a likeness as the appearance of fire—from the appearance of his waist and downward, fire, and from his waist and upward, as the appearance of brightness, as it were glowing metal. ³He stretched out the form of a hand, and took me by a lock of my head; and the Spirit lifted me up between earth and the sky, and brought me in the visions of God to Jerusalem, to the door of the gate of the inner court that looks toward the north, where there was the seat of the image of jealousy, which provokes

to jealousy. ⁴Behold, the glory of the God of Israel was there, according to the appearance that I saw in the plain. ⁵Then he said to me, "Son of man, lift up your eyes now the way toward the north." So I lifted up my eyes the way toward the north, and saw, northward of the gate of the altar this image of jealousy in the entry. ⁶He said to me, "Son of man, do you see what they do? Even the great abominations that the house of Israel commit here, that I should go far off from my sanctuary? But you will again see yet other great abominations." ⁷He brought me to the door of the court; and when I looked, behold, a hole in the wall. ⁸Then he said to me, "Son of man, dig now in the wall." When I had dug in the wall, I saw a door. ⁹He said to me, "Go in, and see the wicked abominations that they do here." ¹⁰So I went in and looked, and saw every form of creeping things, abominable animals, and all the idols of the house of Israel, portrayed around on the wall. ¹¹Seventy men of the elders of the house of Israel stood before them. In the middle of them Jaazaniah the son of Shaphan stood, every man with his censer in his hand; and the smell of the cloud of incense went up. ¹²Then he said to me, "Son of man, have you seen what the elders of the house of Israel do in the dark, every man in his rooms of imagery? For they say, 'The LORD doesn't see us. The LORD has forsaken the land.'" ¹³He said also to me, "You will again see more of the great abominations which they do." ¹⁴Then he brought me to the door of the gate of the LORD's house which was toward the north; and I saw the women sit there weeping for Tammuz. ¹⁵Then he said to me, "Have you seen this, son of man? You will again see yet greater abominations than these." ¹⁶He brought me into the inner court of the LORD's house; and I saw at the door of the LORD's temple, between the porch and the altar, there were about twenty-five men with their backs toward the LORD's temple and their faces toward the east. They were worshipping the sun toward the east. ¹⁷Then he said to me, "Have you seen this, son of man? Is it a light thing to the house of Judah that they commit the abominations which they commit here? For they have filled the land with violence, and have turned again to provoke me to anger. Behold, they put the branch to their nose. ¹⁸Therefore I will also deal in wrath. My eye won't spare, neither will I have pity. Though they cry in my ears with a loud voice, yet I will not hear them."

⁹Then he cried in my ears with a loud voice, saying, "Cause those who are in charge of the city to draw near, each man with his destroying weapon in his hand." ²Behold, six men came from the way of the upper gate, which lies toward the north, every man with his slaughter weapon in his hand. One man in the middle of them was clothed in linen, with a writer's inkhorn by his side. They went in, and stood beside the bronze altar. ³The glory of the God of Israel went up from the cherub, whereupon it was,

to the threshold of the house; and he called to the man clothed in linen, who had the writer's inkhorn by his side. ⁴The LORD said to him, "Go through the middle of the city, through the middle of Jerusalem, and set a mark on the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry over all the abominations that are done within it." ⁵To the others he said in my hearing, "Go through the city after him, and strike. Don't let your eye spare, neither have pity. ⁶Kill utterly the old man, the young man, the virgin, little children and women; but don't come near any man on whom is the mark. Begin at my sanctuary." Then they began at the old men who were before the house. ⁷He said to them, "Defile the house, and fill the courts with the slain. Go out!" They went out, and struck in the city. ⁸While they were killing, and I was left, I fell on my face, and cried, and said, "Ah Lord GOD! Will you destroy all the residue of Israel in your pouring out of your wrath on Jerusalem?" ⁹Then he said to me, "The iniquity of the house of Israel and Judah is exceedingly great, and the land is full of blood, and the city full of perversion; for they say, 'The LORD has forsaken the land, and the LORD doesn't see.' ¹⁰As for me also, my eye won't spare, neither will I have pity, but I will bring their way on their head." ¹¹Behold, the man clothed in linen, who had the inkhorn by his side, reported the matter, saying, "I have done as you have commanded me."

¹⁰Then I looked, and see, in the expanse that was over the head of the cherubim there appeared above them as it were a sapphire ^{ix} stone, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne. ²He spoke to the man clothed in linen, and said, "Go in between the whirling wheels, even under the cherub, and fill both your hands with coals of fire from between the cherubim, and scatter them over the city." He went in as I watched. ³Now the cherubim stood on the right side of the house when the man went in; and the cloud filled the inner court. ⁴The LORD's glory mounted up from the cherub, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of the LORD's glory. ⁵The sound of the wings of the cherubim was heard even to the outer court, as the voice of God Almighty when he speaks. ⁶It came to pass, when he commanded the man clothed in linen, saying, "Take fire from between the whirling wheels, from between the cherubim," that he went in and stood beside a wheel. ⁷The cherub stretched out his hand from between the cherubim to the fire that was between the cherubim, and took some of it, and put it into the hands of him who was clothed in linen, who took it and went out. ⁸The form of a man's hand appeared here in the cherubim under their wings. ⁹I looked, and behold, there were four wheels beside the cherubim, one wheel beside one cherub, and another wheel beside another cherub. The

^{ix}or, lapis lazuli

appearance of the wheels was like a beryl stone. ¹⁰As for their appearance, the four of them had one likeness, like a wheel within a wheel. ¹¹When they went, they went in their four directions. They didn't turn as they went, but to the place where the head looked they followed it. They didn't turn as they went. ¹²Their whole body, including their backs, their hands, their wings, and the wheels, were full of eyes all around, even the wheels that the four of them had. ¹³As for the wheels, they were called in my hearing, "the whirling wheels". ¹⁴Every one of them had four faces. The first face was the face of the cherub. The second face was the face of a man. The third face was the face of a lion. The fourth was the face of an eagle. ¹⁵The cherubim mounted up. This is the living creature that I saw by the river Chebar. ¹⁶When the cherubim went, the wheels went beside them; and when the cherubim lifted up their wings to mount up from the earth, the wheels also didn't turn from beside them. ¹⁷When they stood, these stood. When they mounted up, these mounted up with them; for the spirit of the living creature was in them. ¹⁸The LORD's glory went out from over the threshold of the house and stood over the cherubim. ¹⁹The cherubim lifted up their wings and mounted up from the earth in my sight when they went out, with the wheels beside them. Then they stood at the door of the east gate of the LORD's house; and the glory of the God of Israel was over them above. ²⁰This is the living creature that I saw under the God of Israel by the river Chebar; and I knew that they were cherubim. ²¹Every one had four faces, and every one four wings. The likeness of the hands of a man was under their wings. ²²As for the likeness of their faces, they were the faces which I saw by the river Chebar, their appearances and themselves. They each went straight forward.

¹¹Moreover the Spirit lifted me up and brought me to the east gate of the LORD's house, which looks eastward. Behold, twenty-five men were at the door of the gate; and I saw among them Jaazaniah the son of Azzur, and Pelatiah the son of Benaiah, princes of the people. ²He said to me, "Son of man, these are the men who devise iniquity, and who give wicked counsel in this city; ³who say, 'The time is not near to build houses. This is the cauldron, and we are the meat.' ⁴Therefore prophesy against them. Prophesy, son of man." ⁵The LORD's Spirit fell on me, and he said to me, "Speak, 'The LORD says: "Thus you have said, house of Israel; for I know the things that come into your mind. ⁶You have multiplied your slain in this city, and you have filled its streets with the slain." ⁷"Therefore the Lord GOD says: "Your slain whom you have laid in the middle of it, they are the meat, and this is the cauldron; but you will be brought out of the middle of it. ⁸You have feared the sword; and I will bring the sword on you," says the Lord GOD. ⁹"I will bring you out of the middle of it, and deliver you into the hands of strangers, and will execute

judgments among you. ¹⁰You will fall by the sword. I will judge you in the border of Israel. Then you will know that I am the LORD. ¹¹This will not be your cauldron, neither will you be the meat in the middle of it. I will judge you in the border of Israel. ¹²You will know that I am the LORD, for you have not walked in my statutes. You have not executed my ordinances, but have done after the ordinances of the nations that are around you." ¹³When I prophesied, Pelatiah the son of Benaiah died. Then I fell down on my face, and cried with a loud voice, and said, "Ah Lord GOD! Will you make a full end of the remnant of Israel?" ¹⁴The LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹⁵"Son of man, your brothers, even your brothers, the men of your relatives, and all the house of Israel, all of them, are the ones to whom the inhabitants of Jerusalem have said, 'Go far away from the LORD. This land has been given to us for a possession.' ¹⁶"Therefore say, 'The Lord GOD says: "Whereas I have removed them far off among the nations, and whereas I have scattered them among the countries, yet I will be to them a sanctuary for a little while in the countries where they have come." ¹⁷"Therefore say, 'The Lord GOD says: "I will gather you from the peoples, and assemble you out of the countries where you have been scattered, and I will give you Eretz-Israel." ¹⁸"They will come there, and they will take away all its detestable things and all its abominations from there. ¹⁹I will give them one heart, and I will put a new spirit within them. I will take the stony heart out of their flesh, and will give them a heart of flesh, ²⁰that they may walk in my statutes, and keep my ordinances, and do them. They will be my people, and I will be their God. ²¹But as for them whose heart walks after the heart of their detestable things and their abominations, I will bring their way on their own heads,' says the Lord GOD." ²²Then the cherubim lifted up their wings, and the wheels were beside them. The glory of the God of Israel was over them above. ²³The LORD's glory went up from the middle of the city, and stood on the mountain which is on the east side of the city. ²⁴The Spirit lifted me up, and brought me in the vision by the Spirit of God into Kasdimah, to the captives. So the vision that I had seen went up from me. ²⁵Then I spoke to the captives all the things that the LORD had shown me.

¹²The LORD's word also came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, you dwell in the middle of the rebellious house, who have eyes to see, and don't see, who have ears to hear, and don't hear; for they are a rebellious house. ³"Therefore, you son of man, prepare your baggage for moving, and move by day in their sight. You shall move from your place to another place in their sight. It may be they will consider, though they are a rebellious house. ⁴You shall bring out your baggage by day in their sight, as baggage for moving. You shall go out yourself at evening in their sight, as when men go out into exile. ⁵Dig through the

wall in their sight, and carry your baggage out that way.⁶ In their sight you shall bear it on your shoulder, and carry it out in the dark. You shall cover your face, so that you don't see the land, for I have set you for a sign to the house of Israel."⁷ I did so as I was commanded. I brought out my baggage by day, as baggage for moving, and in the evening I dug through the wall with my hand. I brought it out in the dark, and bore it on my shoulder in their sight.⁸ In the morning, the LORD's word came to me, saying,⁹ "Son of man, hasn't the house of Israel, the rebellious house, said to you, 'What are you doing?'"¹⁰ "Say to them, 'The Lord GOD says: "This burden concerns the prince in Jerusalem, and all the house of Israel among whom they are."'"¹¹ "Say, 'I am your sign. As I have done, so will it be done to them. They will go into exile, into captivity."¹² "The prince who is among them will bear his baggage on his shoulder in the dark, and will go out. They will dig through the wall to carry things out that way. He will cover his face, because he will not see the land with his eyes."¹³ I will also spread my net on him, and he will be taken in my snare. I will bring him to Babylon to the land of the Kasdim; yet he will not see it, though he will die there."¹⁴ I will scatter toward every wind all who are around him to help him, and all his bands. I will draw out the sword after them."¹⁵ "They will know that I am the LORD when I disperse them among the nations and scatter them through the countries."¹⁶ But I will leave a few men of them from the sword, from the famine, and from the pestilence, that they may declare all their abominations among the nations where they come. Then they will know that I am the LORD."¹⁷ Moreover the LORD's word came to me, saying,¹⁸ "Son of man, eat your bread with quaking, and drink your water with trembling and with fearfulness."¹⁹ Tell the people of the land, 'The Lord GOD says concerning the inhabitants of Jerusalem and Eretz-Israel: "They will eat their bread with fearfulness and drink their water in dismay, that her land may be desolate, and all that is therein, because of the violence of all those who dwell therein."²⁰ The cities that are inhabited will be laid waste, and the land will be a desolation. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'" "²¹ The LORD's word came to me, saying,²² "Son of man, what is this proverb that you have in Eretz-Israel, saying, 'The days are prolonged, and every vision fails?'"²³ Tell them therefore, 'The Lord GOD says: "I will make this proverb to cease, and they will no more use it as a proverb in Israel;" but tell them, "'The days are at hand, and the fulfillment of every vision."²⁴ For there will be no more any false vision nor flattering divination within the house of Israel."²⁵ For I am the LORD. I will speak, and the word that I speak will be performed. It will be no more deferred; for in your days, rebellious house, I will speak the word and will perform it," says the Lord GOD."²⁶ Again the LORD's word came to me, saying,²⁷ "Son of man, behold, they of the house of Is-

rael say, 'The vision that he sees is for many days to come, and he prophesies of times that are far off.'²⁸ "Therefore tell them, 'The Lord GOD says: "None of my words will be deferred any more, but the word which I speak will be performed," says the Lord GOD.'"

13 The LORD's word came to me, saying,² "Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel who prophesy, and say to those who prophesy out of their own heart, 'Hear the LORD's word: "³ The Lord GOD says, "Woe to the foolish prophets, who follow their own spirit, and have seen nothing!"⁴ Israel, your prophets have been like foxes in the waste places."⁵ You have not gone up into the gaps or built up the wall for the house of Israel, to stand in the battle in the LORD's day."⁶ They have seen falsehood and lying divination, who say, 'The LORD says;' but the LORD has not sent them. They have made men to hope that the word would be confirmed."⁷ Haven't you seen a false vision, and haven't you spoken a lying divination, in that you say, 'The LORD says;' but I have not spoken?" "⁸ "Therefore the Lord GOD says: "Because you have spoken falsehood and seen lies, therefore, behold, I am against you," says the Lord GOD."⁹ "My hand will be against the prophets who see false visions and who utter lying divinations. They will not be in the council of my people, neither will they be written in the writing of the house of Israel, neither will they enter into Eretz-Israel. Then you will know that I am the Lord GOD."¹⁰ "Because, even because they have seduced my people, saying, "Peace;" and there is no peace. When one builds up a wall, behold, they plaster it with whitewash."¹¹ Tell those who plaster it with whitewash that it will fall. There will be an overflowing shower; and you, great hailstones, will fall. A stormy wind will tear it."¹² Behold, when the wall has fallen, won't it be said to you, "Where is the plaster with which you have plastered it?" "¹³ "Therefore the Lord GOD says: "I will even tear it with a stormy wind in my wrath. There will be an overflowing shower in my anger, and great hailstones in wrath to consume it."¹⁴ So I will break down the wall that you have plastered with whitewash, and bring it down to the ground, so that its foundation will be uncovered. It will fall, and you will be consumed in the middle of it. Then you will know that I am the LORD."¹⁵ Thus I will accomplish my wrath on the wall, and on those who have plastered it with whitewash. I will tell you, 'The wall is no more, nor those who plastered it—"¹⁶ to wit, the prophets of Israel who prophesy concerning Jerusalem, and who see visions of peace for her, and there is no peace,' says the Lord GOD.'" "¹⁷ You, son of man, set your face against the daughters of your people, who prophesy out of their own heart; and prophesy against them,¹⁸ and say, "The Lord GOD says: 'Woe to the women who sew magic bands on all elbows and make veils for the head of persons of every stature to hunt souls! Will you hunt the souls of my people

and save souls alive for yourselves? ¹⁹You have profaned me among my people for handfuls of barley and for pieces of bread, to kill the souls who should not die and to save the souls alive who should not live, by your lying to my people who listen to lies.' ²⁰"Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I am against your magic bands, with which you hunt the souls to make them fly, and I will tear them from your arms. I will let the souls fly free, even the souls whom you ensnare like birds. ²¹I will also tear your veils and deliver my people out of your hand; and they will no longer be in your hand to be ensnared. Then you will know that I am the LORD. ²²Because with lies you have grieved the heart of the righteous, whom I have not made sad; and strengthened the hands of the wicked, that he should not return from his wicked way, and be saved alive. ²³Therefore you shall no more see false visions nor practice divination. I will deliver my people out of your hand. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'

¹⁴Then some of the elders of Israel came to me and sat before me. ²The LORD's word came to me, saying, ³"Son of man, these men have taken their idols into their heart, and put the stumbling block of their iniquity before their face. Should I be inquired of at all by them? ⁴Therefore speak to them and tell them, 'The Lord GOD says: "Every man of the house of Israel who takes his idols into his heart and puts the stumbling block of his iniquity before his face then comes to the prophet, I the LORD will answer him there according to the multitude of his idols, ⁵that I may take the house of Israel in their own heart, because they are all estranged from me through their idols.'" ⁶"Therefore tell the house of Israel, 'The Lord GOD says: "Return, and turn yourselves from your idols! Turn away your faces from all your abominations. ⁷"'"For everyone of the house of Israel, or of the strangers who live in Israel, who separates himself from me and takes his idols into his heart, and puts the stumbling block of his iniquity before his face, and comes to the prophet to inquire for himself of me, I the LORD will answer him by myself. ⁸I will set my face against that man and will make him an astonishment, for a sign and a proverb, and I will cut him off from among my people. Then you will know that I am the LORD. ⁹"'"If the prophet is deceived and speaks a word, I, the LORD, have deceived that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand on him, and will destroy him from among my people Israel. ¹⁰They will bear their iniquity. The iniquity of the prophet will be even as the iniquity of him who seeks him, ¹¹that the house of Israel may no more go astray from me, neither defile themselves any more with all their transgressions; but that they may be my people, and I may be their God," says the Lord GOD.'" ¹²The LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹³"Son of man, when a land sins against me by committing a trespass, and I stretch out my hand on it, and break the staff

of its bread and send famine on it, and cut off from it man and animal—¹⁴though these three men, Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, they would deliver only their own souls by their righteousness," says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵"If I cause evil animals to pass through the land, and they ravage it and it is made desolate, so that no man may pass through because of the animals—¹⁶though these three men were in it, as I live," says the Lord GOD, "they would deliver neither sons nor daughters. They only would be delivered, but the land would be desolate. ¹⁷"Or if I bring a sword on that land, and say, 'Sword, go through the land, so that I cut off from it man and animal'—¹⁸though these three men were in it, as I live," says the Lord GOD, "they would deliver neither sons nor daughters, but they only would be delivered themselves. ¹⁹"Or if I send a pestilence into that land, and pour out my wrath on it in blood, to cut off from it man and animal—²⁰though Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, as I live," says the Lord GOD, "they would deliver neither son nor daughter; they would deliver only their own souls by their righteousness." ²¹For the Lord GOD says: "How much more when I send my four severe judgments on Jerusalem—the sword, the famine, the evil animals, and the pestilence—to cut off from it man and animal! ²²Yet, behold, there will be left a remnant in it that will be carried out, both sons and daughters. Behold, they will come out to you, and you will see their way and their doings. Then you will be comforted concerning the evil that I have brought on Jerusalem, even concerning all that I have brought on it. ²³They will comfort you, when you see their way and their doings; then you will know that I have not done all that I have done in it without cause," says the Lord GOD.

¹⁵The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, what is the vine tree more than any tree, the vine branch which is among the trees of the forest? ³Will wood be taken of it to make anything? Will men take a pin of it to hang any vessel on it? ⁴Behold, it is cast into the fire for fuel; the fire has devoured both its ends, and the middle of it is burned. Is it profitable for any work? ⁵Behold, when it was whole, it was suitable for no work. How much less, when the fire has devoured it, and it has been burned, will it yet be suitable for any work?" ⁶Therefore the Lord GOD says: "As the vine wood among the trees of the forest, which I have given to the fire for fuel, so I will give the inhabitants of Jerusalem. ⁷I will set my face against them. They will go out from the fire, but the fire will still devour them. Then you will know that I am the LORD, when I set my face against them. ⁸I will make the land desolate, because they have acted unfaithfully," says the Lord GOD.

¹⁶Again the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, cause Jerusalem to know her abominations; ³and

say, 'The Lord GOD says to Jerusalem: "Your origin and your birth is of the land of the Canaanite. An Amorite was your father, and your mother was a Hittite. ⁴As for your birth, in the day you were born your navel was not cut. You weren't washed in water to cleanse you. You weren't salted at all, nor wrapped in blankets at all. ⁵No eye pitied you, to do any of these things to you, to have compassion on you; but you were cast out in the open field, because you were abhorred in the day that you were born. ⁶" "When I passed by you, and saw you wallowing in your blood, I said to you, 'Though you are in your blood, live!' Yes, I said to you, 'Though you are in your blood, live!' ⁷I caused you to multiply as that which grows in the field, and you increased and grew great, and you attained to excellent beauty. Your breasts were formed, and your hair grew; yet you were naked and bare. ⁸" "Now when I passed by you, and looked at you, behold, your time was the time of love; and I spread my garment over you and covered your nakedness. Yes, I pledged myself to you and entered into a covenant with you," says the Lord GOD, "and you became mine. ⁹" "Then I washed you with water. Yes, I thoroughly washed away your blood from you, and I anointed you with oil. ¹⁰I clothed you also with embroidered work and put leather sandals on you. I dressed you with fine linen and covered you with silk. ¹¹I decked you with ornaments, put bracelets on your hands, and put a chain on your neck. ¹²I put a ring on your nose, earrings in your ears, and a beautiful crown on your head. ¹³Thus you were decked with gold and silver. Your clothing was of fine linen, silk, and embroidered work. You ate fine flour, honey, and oil. You were exceedingly beautiful, and you prospered to royal estate. ¹⁴Your renown went out among the nations for your beauty; for it was perfect, through my majesty which I had put on you," says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵" "But you trusted in your beauty, and played the prostitute because of your renown, and poured out your prostitution on everyone who passed by. It was his. ¹⁶You took some of your garments, and made for yourselves high places decked with various colors, and played the prostitute on them. This shouldn't happen, neither shall it be. ¹⁷You also took your beautiful jewels of my gold and of my silver, which I had given you, and made for yourself images of men, and played the prostitute with them. ¹⁸You took your embroidered garments, covered them, and set my oil and my incense before them. ¹⁹My bread also which I gave you, fine flour, oil, and honey, with which I fed you, you even set it before them for a pleasant aroma; and so it was," says the Lord GOD. ²⁰" "Moreover you have taken your sons and your daughters, whom you have borne to me, and you have sacrificed these to them to be devoured. Was your prostitution a small matter, ²¹that you have slain my children and delivered them up, in causing them to pass through the fire to them? ²²In all your abominations and your prostitution you have not remembered the days

of your youth, when you were naked and bare, and were wallowing in your blood. ²³" "It has happened after all your wickedness—woe, woe to you!" says the Lord GOD—²⁴"that you have built for yourselves a vaulted place, and have made yourselves a lofty place in every street. ²⁵You have built your lofty place at the head of every way, and have made your beauty an abomination, and have opened your feet to everyone who passed by, and multiplied your prostitution. ²⁶You have also committed sexual immorality with the Egyptians, your neighbors, great of flesh; and have multiplied your prostitution, to provoke me to anger. ²⁷See therefore, I have stretched out my hand over you, and have diminished your portion, and delivered you to the will of those who hate you, the daughters of the Philistines, who are ashamed of your lewd way. ²⁸You have played the prostitute also with the Assyrians, because you were insatiable; yes, you have played the prostitute with them, and yet you weren't satisfied. ²⁹You have moreover multiplied your prostitution to the land of merchants, to Kasdimah; and yet you weren't satisfied with this. ³⁰" "How weak is your heart," says the Lord GOD, "since you do all these things, the work of an impudent prostitute; ³¹in that you build your vaulted place at the head of every way, and make your lofty place in every street, and have not been as a prostitute, in that you scorn pay. ³²" "Adulterous wife, who takes strangers instead of her husband! ³³People give gifts to all prostitutes; but you give your gifts to all your lovers, and bribe them, that they may come to you on every side for your prostitution. ³⁴You are different from other women in your prostitution, in that no one follows you to play the prostitute; and whereas you give hire, and no hire is given to you, therefore you are different." ³⁵"Therefore, prostitute, hear the LORD's word: ³⁶The Lord GOD says, "Because your filthiness was poured out, and your nakedness uncovered through your prostitution with your lovers; and because of all the idols of your abominations, and for the blood of your children, that you gave to them; ³⁷therefore see, I will gather all your lovers, with whom you have taken pleasure, and all those whom you have loved, with all those whom you have hated. I will even gather them against you on every side, and will uncover your nakedness to them, that they may see all your nakedness. ³⁸I will judge you as women who break wedlock and shed blood are judged; and I will bring on you the blood of wrath and jealousy. ³⁹I will also give you into their hand, and they will throw down your vaulted place, and break down your lofty places. They will strip you of your clothes and take your beautiful jewels. They will leave you naked and bare. ⁴⁰They will also bring up a company against you, and they will stone you with stones, and thrust you through with their swords. ⁴¹They will burn your houses with fire, and execute judgments on you in the sight of many women. I will cause you to cease from playing the prostitute, and you will also give no hire

any more. ⁴²So I will cause my wrath toward you to rest, and my jealousy will depart from you. I will be quiet, and will not be angry any more. ⁴³“Because you have not remembered the days of your youth, but have raged against me in all these things; therefore, behold, I also will bring your way on your head,” says the Lord GOD: “and you shall not commit this lewdness with all your abominations. ⁴⁴“Behold, everyone who uses proverbs will use this proverb against you, saying, ‘As is the mother, so is her daughter.’ ⁴⁵You are the daughter of your mother, who loathes her husband and her children; and you are the sister of your sisters, who loathed their husbands and their children. Your mother was a Hittite, and your father an Amorite. ⁴⁶Your elder sister is Samaria, who dwells at your left hand, she and her daughters; and your younger sister, who dwells at your right hand, is Sodom with her daughters. ⁴⁷Yet you have not walked in their ways, nor done their abominations; but soon you were more corrupt than they in all your ways. ⁴⁸As I live,” says the Lord GOD, “Sodom your sister has not done, she nor her daughters, as you have done, you and your daughters. ⁴⁹“Behold, this was the iniquity of your sister Sodom: pride, fullness of bread, and prosperous ease was in her and in her daughters. She also didn’t strengthen the hand of the poor and needy. ⁵⁰They were arrogant and committed abomination before me. Therefore I took them away when I saw it. ⁵¹Samaria hasn’t committed half of your sins; but you have multiplied your abominations more than they, and have justified your sisters by all your abominations which you have done. ⁵²You also bear your own shame yourself, in that you have given judgment for your sisters; through your sins that you have committed more abominable than they, they are more righteous than you. Yes, be also confounded, and bear your shame, in that you have justified your sisters. ⁵³“I will reverse their captivity, the captivity of Sodom and her daughters, and the captivity of Samaria and her daughters, and the captivity of your captives among them; ⁵⁴that you may bear your own shame, and may be ashamed because of all that you have done, in that you are a comfort to them. ⁵⁵Your sisters, Sodom and her daughters, will return to their former estate; and Samaria and her daughters will return to their former estate; and you and your daughters will return to your former estate. ⁵⁶For your sister Sodom was not mentioned by your mouth in the day of your pride, ⁵⁷before your wickedness was uncovered, as at the time of the reproach of the daughters of Syria, and of all who are around her, the daughters of the Philistines, who despise you all around. ⁵⁸You have borne your lewdness and your abominations,” says the LORD. ⁵⁹“For the Lord GOD says: “I will also deal with you as you have done, who have despised the oath in breaking the covenant. ⁶⁰Nevertheless I will remember my covenant with you in the days of your youth, and I will establish an everlasting covenant with you. ⁶¹Then you will remember

your ways and be ashamed when you receive your sisters, your elder sisters and your younger; and I will give them to you for daughters, but not by your covenant. ⁶²I will establish my covenant with you. Then you will know that I am the LORD; ⁶³that you may remember, and be confounded, and never open your mouth any more because of your shame, when I have forgiven you all that you have done,” says the Lord GOD.”

17 The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, tell a riddle, and speak a parable to the house of Israel; ³and say, ‘The Lord GOD says: “A great eagle with great wings and long feathers, full of feathers which had various colors, came to Lebanon and took the top of the cedar. ⁴He cropped off the topmost of its young twigs, and carried it to a land of traffic. He planted it in a city of merchants. ⁵“He also took some of the seed of the land and planted it in fruitful soil. He placed it beside many waters. He set it as a willow tree. ⁶It grew and became a spreading vine of low stature, whose branches turned toward him, and its roots were under him. So it became a vine, produced branches, and shot out sprigs. ⁷“There was also another great eagle with great wings and many feathers. Behold, this vine bent its roots toward him, and shot out its branches toward him, from the ground where it was planted, that he might water it. ⁸It was planted in a good soil by many waters, that it might produce branches and that it might bear fruit, that it might be a good vine.”’ ⁹Say, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Will it prosper? Won’t he pull up its roots and cut off its fruit, that it may wither, that all its fresh springing leaves may wither? It can’t be raised from its roots by a strong arm or many people. ¹⁰Yes, behold, being planted, will it prosper? Won’t it utterly wither when the east wind touches it? It will wither in the ground where it grew.”’” ¹¹Moreover the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ¹²“Say now to the rebellious house, ‘Don’t you know what these things mean?’ Tell them, ‘Behold, the king of Babylon came to Jerusalem, and took its king, and its princes, and brought them to him to Babylon. ¹³He took one of the royal offspring, ^x and made a covenant with him. He also brought him under an oath, and took away the mighty of the land, ¹⁴that the kingdom might be brought low, that it might not lift itself up, but that by keeping his covenant it might stand. ¹⁵But he rebelled against him in sending his ambassadors into Egypt, that they might give him horses and many people. Will he prosper? Will he who does such things escape? Will he break the covenant, and still escape? ¹⁶“As I live,’ says the Lord GOD, ‘surely in the place where the king dwells who made him king, whose oath he despised, and whose covenant he broke, even with him in the middle of Babylon he will die. ¹⁷Pharaoh with his mighty army and great company won’t help him in the war, when they

^xor, seed

cast up mounds and build forts to cut off many persons.¹⁸For he has despised the oath by breaking the covenant; and behold, he had given his hand, and yet has done all these things. He won't escape.¹⁹"Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'As I live, I will surely bring on his own head my oath that he has despised and my covenant that he has broken.²⁰I will spread my net on him, and he will be taken in my snare. I will bring him to Babylon, and will enter into judgment with him there for his trespass that he has trespassed against me.²¹All his fugitives in all his bands will fall by the sword, and those who remain will be scattered toward every wind. Then you will know that I, the LORD, have spoken it.'²²"The Lord GOD says: 'I will also take some of the lofty top of the cedar, and will plant it. I will crop off from the topmost of its young twigs a tender one, and I will plant it on a high and lofty mountain.²³I will plant it in the mountain of the height of Israel; and it will produce boughs, and bear fruit, and be a good cedar. Birds of every kind will dwell in the shade of its branches.²⁴All the trees of the field will know that I, the LORD, have brought down the high tree, have exalted the low tree, have dried up the green tree, and have made the dry tree flourish. "I, the LORD, have spoken and have done it.'"

18The LORD's word came to me again, saying, ²"What do you mean, that you use this proverb concerning Eretz-Israel, saying, 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge'? ³"As I live," says the Lord GOD, "you shall not use this proverb any more in Israel. ⁴Behold, all souls are mine; as the soul of the father, so also the soul of the son is mine. The soul who sins, he shall die. ⁵"But if a man is just, and does that which is lawful and right, ⁶and has not eaten on the mountains, hasn't lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, hasn't defiled his neighbor's wife, hasn't come near a woman in her impurity, ⁷and has not wronged any, but has restored to the debtor his pledge, has taken nothing by robbery, has given his bread to the hungry, and has covered the naked with a garment; ⁸he who hasn't lent to them with interest, hasn't taken any increase from them, who has withdrawn his hand from iniquity, has executed true justice between man and man, ⁹has walked in my statutes, and has kept my ordinances, to deal truly; he is just, he shall surely live," says the Lord GOD. ¹⁰"If he fathers a son who is a robber who sheds blood, and who does any one of these things, ¹¹or who does not do any of those things but has eaten at the mountain shrines and defiled his neighbor's wife, ¹²has wronged the poor and needy, has taken by robbery, has not restored the pledge, and has lifted up his eyes to the idols, has committed abomination, ¹³has lent with interest, and has taken increase from the poor, shall he then live? He shall not live. He has done all these abominations. He shall surely die. His blood will be on him.

¹⁴"Now, behold, if he fathers a son who sees all his father's sins which he has done, and fears, and doesn't do likewise, ¹⁵who hasn't eaten on the mountains, hasn't lifted up his eyes to the idols of the house of Israel, hasn't defiled his neighbor's wife, ¹⁶hasn't wronged any, hasn't taken anything to pledge, hasn't taken by robbery, but has given his bread to the hungry, and has covered the naked with a garment; ¹⁷who has withdrawn his hand from the poor, who hasn't received interest or increase, has executed my ordinances, has walked in my statutes; he shall not die for the iniquity of his father. He shall surely live. ¹⁸As for his father, because he cruelly oppressed, robbed his brother, and did that which is not good among his people, behold, he will die in his iniquity. ¹⁹"Yet you say, 'Why doesn't the son bear the iniquity of the father?' When the son has done that which is lawful and right, and has kept all my statutes, and has done them, he will surely live. ²⁰The soul who sins, he shall die. The son shall not bear the iniquity of the father, neither shall the father bear the iniquity of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be on him, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be on him. ²¹"But if the wicked turns from all his sins that he has committed, and keeps all my statutes, and does that which is lawful and right, he shall surely live. He shall not die. ²²None of his transgressions that he has committed will be remembered against him. In his righteousness that he has done, he shall live. ²³Have I any pleasure in the death of the wicked?" says the Lord GOD, "and not rather that he should return from his way, and live? ²⁴"But when the righteous turns away from his righteousness, and commits iniquity, and does according to all the abominations that the wicked man does, should he live? None of his righteous deeds that he has done will be remembered. In his trespass that he has trespassed, and in his sin that he has sinned, in them he shall die. ²⁵"Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not equal.' Hear now, house of Israel: Is my way not equal? Aren't your ways unequal? ²⁶When the righteous man turns away from his righteousness, and commits iniquity, and dies in it, then he dies in his iniquity that he has done. ²⁷Again, when the wicked man turns away from his wickedness that he has committed, and does that which is lawful and right, he will save his soul alive. ²⁸Because he considers, and turns away from all his transgressions that he has committed, he shall surely live. He shall not die. ²⁹Yet the house of Israel says, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' House of Israel, aren't my ways fair? Aren't your ways unfair? ³⁰"Therefore I will judge you, house of Israel, everyone according to his ways," says the Lord GOD. "Return, and turn yourselves from all your transgressions, so iniquity will not be your ruin. ³¹Cast away from you all your transgressions in which you have transgressed; and make yourself a new heart and a new spirit. For why will you die, house of Israel? ³²For I have no pleasure in the death of him who dies," says the Lord GOD. "Therefore

turn yourselves, and live!

19“Moreover, take up a lamentation for the princes of Israel, ²and say, ‘What was your mother? A lioness. She couched among lions, in the middle of the young lions she nourished her cubs. ³She brought up one of her cubs. He became a young lion. He learned to catch the prey. He devoured men. ⁴The nations also heard of him. He was taken in their pit; and they brought him with hooks to the land of Egypt. ⁵“Now when she saw that she had waited, and her hope was lost, then she took another of her cubs, and made him a young lion. ⁶He went up and down among the lions. He became a young lion. He learned to catch the prey. He devoured men. ⁷He knew their palaces, and laid waste their cities. The land was desolate with its fullness, because of the noise of his roaring. ⁸Then the nations attacked him on every side from the provinces. They spread their net over him. He was taken in their pit. ⁹They put him in a cage with hooks, and brought him to the king of Babylon. They brought him into strongholds, so that his voice should no more be heard on the mountains of Israel. ¹⁰“Your mother was like a vine in your blood, planted by the waters. It was fruitful and full of branches by reason of many waters. ¹¹It had strong branches for the scepters of those who ruled. Their stature was exalted among the thick boughs. They were seen in their height with the multitude of their branches. ¹²But it was plucked up in fury. It was cast down to the ground, and the east wind dried up its fruit. Its strong branches were broken off and withered. The fire consumed them. ¹³Now it is planted in the wilderness, in a dry and thirsty land. ¹⁴Fire has gone out of its branches. It has devoured its fruit, so that there is in it no strong branch to be a scepter to rule.’ This is a lamentation, and shall be for a lamentation.”

20In the seventh year, in the fifth month, the tenth day of the month, some of the elders of Israel came to inquire of the LORD, and sat before me. ²The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ³“Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel, and tell them, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Is it to inquire of me that you have come? As I live,” says the Lord GOD, “I will not be inquired of by you.”’ ⁴“Will you judge them, son of man? Will you judge them? Cause them to know the abominations of their fathers. ⁵Tell them, ‘The Lord GOD says: “In the day when I chose Israel, and swore to the offspring of the house of Jacob, and made myself known to them in the land of Egypt, when I swore to them, saying, ‘I am the LORD your God;’ ⁶in that day I swore to them to bring them out of the land of Egypt into a land that I had searched out for them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands. ⁷I said to them, ‘Each of you throw away the abominations of his eyes. Don’t defile yourselves with the idols of Egypt. I am the LORD your God.’ ⁸““But they rebelled against me and wouldn’t lis-

ten to me. They didn’t all throw away the abominations of their eyes. They also didn’t forsake the idols of Egypt. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them, to accomplish my anger against them in the middle of the land of Egypt. ⁹But I worked for my name’s sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations among which they were, in whose sight I made myself known to them in bringing them out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁰So I caused them to go out of the land of Egypt and brought them into the wilderness. ¹¹I gave them my statutes and showed them my ordinances, which if a man does, he will live in them. ¹²Moreover also I gave them my Sabbaths, to be a sign between me and them, that they might know that I am the LORD who sanctifies them. ¹³““But the house of Israel rebelled against me in the wilderness. They didn’t walk in my statutes and they rejected my ordinances, which if a man keeps, he shall live in them. They greatly profaned my Sabbaths. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them in the wilderness, to consume them. ¹⁴But I worked for my name’s sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations, in whose sight I brought them out. ¹⁵Moreover also I swore to them in the wilderness that I would not bring them into the land which I had given them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands, ¹⁶because they rejected my ordinances, and didn’t walk in my statutes, and profaned my Sabbaths; for their heart went after their idols. ¹⁷Nevertheless my eye spared them, and I didn’t destroy them. I didn’t make a full end of them in the wilderness. ¹⁸I said to their children in the wilderness, ‘Don’t walk in the statutes of your fathers. Don’t observe their ordinances or defile yourselves with their idols. ¹⁹I am the LORD your God. Walk in my statutes, keep my ordinances, and do them. ²⁰Make my Sabbaths holy. They shall be a sign between me and you, that you may know that I am the LORD your God.’ ²¹““But the children rebelled against me. They didn’t walk in my statutes, and didn’t keep my ordinances to do them, which if a man does, he shall live in them. They profaned my Sabbaths. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them, to accomplish my anger against them in the wilderness. ²²Nevertheless I withdrew my hand and worked for my name’s sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations, in whose sight I brought them out. ²³Moreover I swore to them in the wilderness, that I would scatter them among the nations and disperse them through the countries, ²⁴because they had not executed my ordinances, but had rejected my statutes, and had profaned my Sabbaths, and their eyes were after their fathers’ idols. ²⁵Moreover also I gave them statutes that were not good, and ordinances in which they couldn’t live. ²⁶I polluted them in their own gifts, in that they caused all that opens the womb to pass through the fire, that I might make them desolate, to the end that they might know that I am the LORD.”’ ²⁷“Therefore, son of man, speak to the house of Israel, and tell them,

‘The Lord GOD says: “Moreover, in this your fathers have blasphemed me, in that they have committed a trespass against me. ²⁸For when I had brought them into the land which I swore to give to them, then they saw every high hill and every thick tree, and they offered there their sacrifices, and there they presented the provocation of their offering. There they also made their pleasant aroma, and there they poured out their drink offerings. ²⁹Then I said to them, ‘What does the high place where you go mean?’ So its name is called Bamah ^{xi} to this day.”’ ³⁰“Therefore tell the house of Israel, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Do you pollute yourselves in the way of your fathers? Do you play the prostitute after their abominations? ³¹When you offer your gifts, when you make your sons pass through the fire, do you pollute yourselves with all your idols to this day? Should I be inquired of by you, house of Israel? As I live, says the Lord GOD, I will not be inquired of by you! ³²““That which comes into your mind will not be at all, in that you say, ‘We will be as the nations, as the families of the countries, to serve wood and stone.’ ³³As I live,” says the Lord GOD, “surely with a mighty hand, with an outstretched arm, and with wrath poured out, I will be king over you. ³⁴I will bring you out from the peoples, and will gather you out of the countries in which you are scattered with a mighty hand, with an outstretched arm, and with wrath poured out. ³⁵I will bring you into the wilderness of the peoples, and there I will enter into judgment with you face to face. ³⁶Just as I entered into judgment with your fathers in the wilderness of the land of Egypt, so I will enter into judgment with you,” says the Lord GOD. ³⁷“I will cause you to pass under the rod, and I will bring you into the bond of the covenant. ³⁸I will purge out from among you the rebels and those who disobey me. I will bring them out of the land where they live, but they shall not enter into Eretz-Israel. Then you will know that I am the LORD.” ³⁹“As for you, house of Israel, the Lord GOD says: “Go, everyone serve his idols, and hereafter also, if you will not listen to me; but you shall no more profane my holy name with your gifts and with your idols. ⁴⁰For in my holy mountain, in the mountain of the height of Israel,” says the Lord GOD, “there all the house of Israel, all of them, shall serve me in the land. There I will accept them, and there I will require your offerings and the first fruits of your offerings, with all your holy things. ⁴¹I will accept you as a pleasant aroma when I bring you out from the peoples and gather you out of the countries in which you have been scattered. I will be sanctified in you in the sight of the nations. ⁴²You will know that I am the LORD when I bring you into Eretz-Israel, into the country which I swore to give to your fathers. ⁴³There you will remember your ways, and all your deeds in which you have polluted yourselves. Then you will loathe yourselves in your own sight for all your evils that you have committed. ⁴⁴You will

know that I am the LORD, when I have dealt with you for my name’s sake, not according to your evil ways, nor according to your corrupt doings, you house of Israel,” says the Lord GOD.’” ⁴⁵The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ⁴⁶“Son of man, set your face toward the south, and proclaim toward the south, and prophesy against the forest of the field in the South. ⁴⁷Tell the forest of the South, ‘Hear the LORD’s word: The Lord GOD says, “Behold, I will kindle a fire in you, and it will devour every green tree in you, and every dry tree. The burning flame will not be quenched, and all faces from the south to the north will be burned by it. ⁴⁸All flesh will see that I, the LORD, have kindled it. It will not be quenched.”’” ⁴⁹Then I said, “Ah Lord GOD! They say of me, ‘Isn’t he a speaker of parables?’”

²¹The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, set your face toward Jerusalem, and proclaim toward the sanctuaries, and prophesy against Eretz-Israel. ³Tell Eretz-Israel, ‘The LORD says: “Behold, I am against you, and will draw my sword out of its sheath, and will cut off from you the righteous and the wicked. ⁴Seeing then that I will cut off from you the righteous and the wicked, therefore my sword will go out of its sheath against all flesh from the south to the north. ⁵All flesh will know that I, the LORD, have drawn my sword out of its sheath. It will not return any more.”’ ⁶“Therefore sigh, you son of man. You shall sigh before their eyes with a broken heart ^{xii} and with bitterness. ⁷It shall be, when they ask you, ‘Why do you sigh?’ that you shall say, ‘Because of the news, for it comes! Every heart will melt, all hands will be feeble, every spirit will faint, and all knees will be weak as water. Behold, it comes, and it shall be done, says the Lord GOD.’” ⁸The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ⁹“Son of man, prophesy, and say, ‘The LORD says: “A sword! A sword! It is sharpened, and also polished. ¹⁰It is sharpened that it may make a slaughter. It is polished that it may be as lightning. Should we then make mirth? The rod of my son condemns every tree. ¹¹It is given to be polished, that it may be handled. The sword is sharpened. Yes, it is polished to give it into the hand of the killer.”’ ¹²Cry and wail, son of man; for it is on my people. It is on all the princes of Israel. They are delivered over to the sword with my people. Therefore beat your thigh. ¹³“For there is a trial. What if even the rod that condemns will be no more?” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁴“You therefore, son of man, prophesy, and strike your hands together. Let the sword be doubled the third time, the sword of the fatally wounded. It is the sword of the great one who is fatally wounded, which enters into their rooms. ¹⁵I have set the threatening sword against all their gates, that their heart may melt, and their stumblings be multiplied. Ah! It is made as lightning. It is pointed for slaughter. ¹⁶Gather

^{xi}“Bamah” means “High Place”.

^{xii}literally, the breaking of your thighs

yourselves together. Go to the right. Set yourselves in array. Go to the left, wherever your face is set. ¹⁷I will also strike my hands together, and I will cause my wrath to rest. I, the LORD, have spoken it.” ¹⁸The LORD’s word came to me again, saying, ¹⁹“Also, you son of man, appoint two ways, that the sword of the king of Babylon may come. They both will come out of one land, and mark out a place. Mark it out at the head of the way to the city. ²⁰You shall appoint a way for the sword to come to Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and to Judah in Jerusalem the fortified. ²¹For the king of Babylon stood at the parting of the way, at the head of the two ways, to use divination. He shook the arrows back and forth. He consulted the teraphim. ^{xiii} He looked in the liver. ²²In his right hand was the lot for Jerusalem, to set battering rams, to open the mouth in the slaughter, to lift up the voice with shouting, to set battering rams against the gates, to cast up mounds, and to build forts. ²³It will be to them as a false divination in their sight, who have sworn oaths to them; but he brings iniquity to memory, that they may be taken. ²⁴“Therefore the Lord GOD says: ‘Because you have caused your iniquity to be remembered, in that your transgressions are uncovered, so that in all your doings your sins appear; because you have come to memory, you will be taken with the hand. ²⁵“You, deadly wounded wicked one, the prince of Israel, whose day has come, in the time of the iniquity of the end, ²⁶the Lord GOD says: ‘Remove the turban, and take off the crown. This will not be as it was. Exalt that which is low, and humble that which is high. ²⁷I will overturn, overturn, overturn it. This also will be no more, until he comes whose right it is; and I will give it.”’ ²⁸“You, son of man, prophesy and say, ‘The Lord GOD says this concerning the children of Ammon, and concerning their reproach: “A sword! A sword is drawn! It is polished for the slaughter, to cause it to devour, that it may be as lightning; ²⁹while they see for you false visions, while they divine lies to you, to lay you on the necks of the wicked who are deadly wounded, whose day has come in the time of the iniquity of the end. ³⁰Cause it to return into its sheath. In the place where you were created, in the land of your birth, I will judge you. ³¹I will pour out my indignation on you. I will blow on you with the fire of my wrath. I will deliver you into the hand of brutish men, skillful to destroy. ³²You will be for fuel to the fire. Your blood will be in the middle of the land. You will be remembered no more; for I, the LORD, have spoken it.”’”

22Moreover the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²⁴“You, son of man, will you judge? Will you judge the bloody city? Then cause her to know all her abominations. ³You shall say, ‘The Lord GOD says: “A city that sheds blood

within herself, that her time may come, and that makes idols against herself to defile her! ⁴You have become guilty in your blood that you have shed, and are defiled in your idols which you have made! You have caused your days to draw near, and have come to the end of your years. Therefore I have made you a reproach to the nations, and a mocking to all the countries. ⁵Those who are near and those who are far from you will mock you, you infamous one, full of tumult. ⁶““Behold, the princes of Israel, everyone according to his power, have been in you to shed blood. ⁷In you have they treated father and mother with contempt. ^{xiv} Among you they have oppressed the foreigner. In you they have wronged the fatherless and the widow. ⁸You have despised my holy things, and have profaned my Sabbaths. ⁹Slandorous men have been in you to shed blood. In you they have eaten on the mountains. They have committed lewdness among you. ¹⁰In you have they uncovered their fathers’ nakedness. In you have they humbled her who was unclean in her impurity. ¹¹One has committed abomination with his neighbor’s wife, and another has lewdly defiled his daughter-in-law. Another in you has humbled his sister, his father’s daughter. ¹²In you have they taken bribes to shed blood. You have taken interest and increase, and you have greedily gained of your neighbors by oppression, and have forgotten me,” says the Lord GOD. ¹³““Behold, therefore I have struck my hand at your dishonest gain which you have made, and at the blood which has been shed within you. ¹⁴Can your heart endure, or can your hands be strong, in the days that I will deal with you? I, the LORD, have spoken it, and will do it. ¹⁵I will scatter you among the nations, and disperse you through the countries. I will purge your filthiness out of you. ¹⁶You will be profaned in yourself in the sight of the nations. Then you will know that I am the LORD.”’” ¹⁷The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ¹⁸“Son of man, the house of Israel has become dross to me. All of them are bronze, tin, iron, and lead in the middle of the furnace. They are the dross of silver. ¹⁹Therefore the Lord GOD says: ‘Because you have all become dross, therefore, behold, I will gather you into the middle of Jerusalem. ²⁰As they gather silver, bronze, iron, lead, and tin into the middle of the furnace, to blow the fire on it, to melt it, so I will gather you in my anger and in my wrath, and I will lay you there and melt you. ²¹Yes, I will gather you, and blow on you with the fire of my wrath, and you will be melted in the middle of it. ²²As silver is melted in the middle of the furnace, so you will be melted in the middle of it; and you will know that I, the LORD, have poured out my wrath on you.”’ ²³The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²⁴“Son of man, tell her, ‘You are a land that is not cleansed nor rained on in the day of indignation.’ ²⁵There is a conspiracy of her prophets within it, like a roaring lion ravening the prey. They have devoured souls. They

^{xiii}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

^{xiv}Literally,

take treasure and precious things. They have made many widows within it. ²⁶Her priests have done violence to my law and have profaned my holy things. They have made no distinction between the holy and the common, neither have they caused men to discern between the unclean and the clean, and have hidden their eyes from my Sabbaths. So I am profaned among them. ²⁷Her princes within it are like wolves ravening the prey, to shed blood and to destroy souls, that they may get dishonest gain. ²⁸Her prophets have plastered for them with whitewash, seeing false visions, and divining lies to them, saying, 'The Lord GOD says,' when the LORD has not spoken. ²⁹The people of the land have used oppression and exercised robbery. Yes, they have troubled the poor and needy, and have oppressed the foreigner wrongfully. ³⁰'I sought for a man among them who would build up the wall and stand in the gap before me for the land, that I would not destroy it; but I found no one. ³¹Therefore I have poured out my indignation on them. I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath. I have brought their own way on their heads,' says the Lord GOD.

23The LORD's word came again to me, saying, ²'Son of man, there were two women, the daughters of one mother. ³They played the prostitute in Egypt. They played the prostitute in their youth. Their breasts were fondled there, and their youthful nipples were caressed there. ⁴Their names were Oholah the elder, and Oholibah her sister. They became mine, and they bore sons and daughters. As for their names, Samaria is Oholah, and Jerusalem Oholibah. ⁵'Oholah played the prostitute when she was mine. She doted on her lovers, on the Assyrians her neighbors, ⁶who were clothed with blue—governors and rulers, all of them desirable young men, horsemen riding on horses. ⁷She gave herself as a prostitute to them, all of them the choicest men of Assyria. She defiled herself with the idols of whoever she lusted after. ⁸She hasn't left her prostitution since leaving Egypt; for in her youth they lay with her. They caressed her youthful nipples and they poured out their prostitution on her. ⁹'Therefore I delivered her into the hand of her lovers, into the hand of the Assyrians on whom she doted. ¹⁰These uncovered her nakedness. They took her sons and her daughters, and they killed her with the sword. She became a byword among women; for they executed judgments on her. ¹¹'Her sister Oholibah saw this, yet she was more corrupt in her lusting than she, and in her prostitution which was more depraved than the prostitution of her sister. ¹²She lusted after the Assyrians, governors and rulers—her neighbors, clothed most gorgeously, horsemen riding on horses, all of them desirable young men. ¹³I saw that she was defiled. They both went the same way. ¹⁴'She increased her prostitution; for she saw men portrayed on the wall, the images of the Kasdim portrayed with red, ¹⁵dressed with belts on

their waists, with flowing turbans on their heads, all of them looking like princes, after the likeness of the Babylonians in Kasdim, the land of their birth. ¹⁶As soon as she saw them, she lusted after them and sent messengers to them into Kasdimah. ¹⁷The Babylonians came to her into the bed of love, and they defiled her with their prostitution. She was polluted with them, and her soul was alienated from them. ¹⁸So she uncovered her prostitution and uncovered her nakedness. Then my soul was alienated from her, just like my soul was alienated from her sister. ¹⁹Yet she multiplied her prostitution, remembering the days of her youth, in which she had played the prostitute in the land of Egypt. ²⁰She lusted after their lovers, whose flesh is as the flesh of donkeys, and whose issue is like the issue of horses. ²¹Thus you called to memory the lewdness of your youth, in the caressing of your nipples by the Egyptians because of your youthful breasts. ²²'Therefore, Oholibah, the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will raise up your lovers against you, from whom your soul is alienated, and I will bring them against you on every side: ²³the Babylonians and all the Kasdim, Pekod, Shoa, Koa, and all the Assyrians with them; all of them desirable young men, governors and rulers, princes and men of renown, all of them riding on horses. ²⁴They will come against you with weapons, chariots, and wagons, and with a company of peoples. They will set themselves against you with buckler, shield, and helmet all around. I will commit the judgment to them, and they will judge you according to their judgments. ²⁵I will set my jealousy against you, and they will deal with you in fury. They will take away your nose and your ears. Your remnant will fall by the sword. They will take your sons and your daughters; and the rest of you will be devoured by the fire. ²⁶They will also strip you of your clothes and take away your beautiful jewels. ²⁷Thus I will make your lewdness to cease from you, and remove your prostitution from the land of Egypt, so that you will not lift up your eyes to them, nor remember Egypt any more.' ²⁸'For the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will deliver you into the hand of them whom you hate, into the hand of them from whom your soul is alienated. ²⁹They will deal with you in hatred, and will take away all your labor, and will leave you naked and bare. The nakedness of your prostitution will be uncovered, both your lewdness and your prostitution. ³⁰These things will be done to you because you have played the prostitute after the nations, and because you are polluted with their idols. ³¹You have walked in the way of your sister; therefore I will give her cup into your hand.' ³²'The Lord GOD says: 'You will drink of your sister's cup, which is deep and large. You will be ridiculed and held in derision. It contains much. ³³You will be filled with drunkenness and sorrow, with the cup of astonishment and desolation, with the cup of your sister Samaria. ³⁴You will even drink it and drain it out. You will gnaw the broken pieces of it, and will tear your breasts;

for I have spoken it,' says the Lord GOD. ³⁵"Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'Because you have forgotten me and cast me behind your back, therefore you also bear your lewdness and your prostitution.'" ³⁶The LORD said moreover to me: "Son of man, will you judge Oholah and Oholibah? Then declare to them their abominations. ³⁷For they have committed adultery, and blood is in their hands. They have committed adultery with their idols. They have also caused their sons, whom they bore to me, to pass through the fire to them to be devoured. ³⁸Moreover this they have done to me: they have defiled my sanctuary in the same day, and have profaned my Sabbaths. ³⁹For when they had slain their children to their idols, then they came the same day into my sanctuary to profane it; and behold, they have done this in the middle of my house. ⁴⁰"Furthermore you sisters have sent for men who come from far away, to whom a messenger was sent, and behold, they came; for whom you washed yourself, painted your eyes, decorated yourself with ornaments, ⁴¹and sat on a stately bed, with a table prepared before it, whereupon you set my incense and my oil. ⁴²"The voice of a multitude being at ease was with her. With men of the common sort were brought drunkards from the wilderness; and they put bracelets on their hands, and beautiful crowns on their heads. ⁴³Then I said of her who was old in adulteries, 'Now they will play the prostitute with her, and she with them.' ⁴⁴They went in to her, as they go in to a prostitute. So they went in to Oholah and to Oholibah, the lewd women. ⁴⁵Righteous men will judge them with the judgment of adulteresses and with the judgment of women who shed blood, because they are adulteresses, and blood is in their hands. ⁴⁶"For the Lord GOD says: 'I will bring up a mob against them, and will give them to be tossed back and forth and robbed. ⁴⁷The company will stone them with stones and dispatch them with their swords. They will kill their sons and their daughters, and burn up their houses with fire. ⁴⁸"Thus I will cause lewdness to cease out of the land, that all women may be taught not to be lewd like you. ⁴⁹They will recompense your lewdness on you, and you will bear the sins of your idols. Then you will know that I am the Lord GOD.'"

²⁴Again, in the ninth year, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, write the name of the day, this same day. The king of Babylon drew close to Jerusalem this same day. ³Utter a parable to the rebellious house, and tell them, 'The Lord GOD says, "Put the cauldron on the fire. Put it on, and also pour water into it. ⁴Gather its pieces into it, even every good piece: the thigh and the shoulder. Fill it with the choice bones. ⁵Take the choice of the flock, and also a pile of wood for the bones under the cauldron. Make it boil well. Yes, let its bones be boiled within it.'" ⁶"Therefore the Lord GOD says: "Woe to the bloody city, to the cauldron whose rust is in it, and

whose rust hasn't gone out of it! Take out of it piece after piece without casting lots for it. ⁷"For the blood she shed is in the middle of her. She set it on the bare rock. She didn't pour it on the ground, to cover it with dust. ⁸That it may cause wrath to come up to take vengeance, I have set her blood on the bare rock, that it should not be covered." ⁹"Therefore the Lord GOD says: "Woe to the bloody city! I also will make the pile great. ¹⁰Heap on the wood. Make the fire hot. Boil the meat well. Make the broth thick, and let the bones be burned. ¹¹Then set it empty on its coals, that it may be hot, and its bronze may burn, and that its filthiness may be molten in it, that its rust may be consumed. ¹²She is weary with toil; yet her great rust, rust by fire, doesn't leave her. ¹³"In your filthiness is lewdness. Because I have cleansed you and you weren't cleansed, you won't be cleansed from your filthiness any more, until I have caused my wrath toward you to rest. ¹⁴"I, the LORD, have spoken it. It will happen, and I will do it. I won't go back. I won't spare. I won't repent. According to your ways and according to your doings, they will judge you," says the Lord GOD.'" ¹⁵Also the LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹⁶"Son of man, behold, I will take away from you the desire of your eyes with one stroke; yet you shall neither mourn nor weep, neither shall your tears run down. ¹⁷Sigh, but not aloud. Make no mourning for the dead. Bind your headress on you, and put your sandals on your feet. Don't cover your lips, and don't eat mourner's bread." ¹⁸So I spoke to the people in the morning, and at evening my wife died. So I did in the morning as I was commanded. ¹⁹The people asked me, "Won't you tell us what these things mean to us, that you act like this?" ²⁰Then I said to them, "The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²¹'Speak to the house of Israel, "The Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will profane my sanctuary, the pride of your power, the desire of your eyes, and that which your soul pities; and your sons and your daughters whom you have left behind will fall by the sword. ²²You will do as I have done. You won't cover your lips or eat mourner's bread. ²³Your turbans will be on your heads, and your sandals on your feet. You won't mourn or weep; but you will pine away in your iniquities, and moan one toward another. ²⁴Thus Ezekiel will be a sign to you; according to all that he has done, you will do. When this comes, then you will know that I am the Lord GOD.'" ²⁵"You, son of man, shouldn't it be in the day when I take from them their strength, the joy of their glory, the desire of their eyes, and that whereupon they set their heart—their sons and their daughters—²⁶that in that day he who escapes will come to you, to cause you to hear it with your ears? ²⁷In that day your mouth will be opened to him who has escaped, and you will speak and be no more mute. So you will be a sign to them. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

25The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, set your face toward the children of Ammon, and prophesy against them. ³Tell the children of Ammon, 'Hear the word of the Lord GOD! The Lord GOD says, "Because you said, 'Aha!' against my sanctuary when it was profaned, and against Eretz-Israel when it was made desolate, and against the house of Judah when they went into captivity, ⁴therefore, behold, I will deliver you to the children of the east for a possession. They will set their encampments in you and make their dwellings in you. They will eat your fruit and they will drink your milk. ⁵I will make Rabbah a stable for camels and the children of Ammon a resting place for flocks. Then you will know that I am the LORD." ⁶For the Lord GOD says: "Because you have clapped your hands, stamped with the feet, and rejoiced with all the contempt of your soul against Eretz-Israel, ⁷therefore, behold, I have stretched out my hand on you, and will deliver you for a plunder to the nations. I will cut you off from the peoples, and I will cause you to perish out of the countries. I will destroy you. Then you will know that I am the LORD." ⁸"The Lord GOD says: "Because Moab and Seir say, 'Behold, the house of Judah is like all the nations,' ⁹therefore, behold, I will open the side of Moab from the cities, from his cities which are on its frontiers, the glory of the country, Beth Jeshimoth, Baal Meon, and Kiriathaim, ¹⁰to the children of the east, to go against the children of Ammon; and I will give them for a possession, that the children of Ammon may not be remembered among the nations. ¹¹I will execute judgments on Moab. Then they will know that I am the LORD." ¹²"The Lord GOD says: "Because Edom has dealt against the house of Judah by taking vengeance, and has greatly offended, and taken revenge on them," ¹³therefore the Lord GOD says, "I will stretch out my hand on Edom, and will cut off man and animal from it; and I will make it desolate from Teman. They will fall by the sword even to Dedan. ¹⁴I will lay my vengeance on Edom by the hand of my people Israel. They will do in Edom according to my anger and according to my wrath. Then they will know my vengeance," says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵"The Lord GOD says: "Because the Philistines have taken revenge, and have taken vengeance with contempt of soul to destroy with perpetual hostility," ¹⁶therefore the Lord GOD says, "Behold, I will stretch out my hand on the Philistines, and I will cut off the Cherethites, and destroy the remnant of the sea coast. ¹⁷I will execute great vengeance on them with wrathful rebukes. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I lay my vengeance on them."'"

26In the eleventh year, in the first of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, because Tyre has said against Jerusalem, 'Aha! She is broken! She who was the gateway of the peoples has been returned to me. I will be replenished, now that she is laid waste;'

³therefore the Lord GOD says, 'Behold, I am against you, Tyre, and will cause many nations to come up against you, as the sea causes its waves to come up. ⁴They will destroy the walls of Tyre, and break down her towers. I will also scrape her dust from her, and make her a bare rock. ⁵She will be a place for the spreading of nets in the middle of the sea; for I have spoken it,' says the Lord GOD. 'She will become plunder for the nations. ⁶Her daughters who are in the field will be slain with the sword. Then they will know that I am the LORD.' ⁷"For the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will bring on Tyre Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, king of kings, from the north, with horses, with chariots, with horsemen, and an army with many people. ⁸He will kill your daughters in the field with the sword. He will make forts against you, cast up a mound against you, and raise up the buckler against you. ⁹He will set his battering engines against your walls, and with his axes he will break down your towers. ¹⁰By reason of the abundance of his horses, their dust will cover you. Your walls will shake at the noise of the horsemen, of the wagons, and of the chariots, when he enters into your gates, as men enter into a city which is broken open. ¹¹He will tread down all your streets with the hoofs of his horses. He will kill your people with the sword. The pillars of your strength will go down to the ground. ¹²They will make a plunder of your riches and make a prey of your merchandise. They will break down your walls and destroy your pleasant houses. They will lay your stones, your timber, and your dust in the middle of the waters. ¹³I will cause the noise of your songs to cease. The sound of your harps won't be heard any more. ¹⁴I will make you a bare rock. You will be a place for the spreading of nets. You will be built no more; for I the LORD have spoken it,' says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵"The Lord GOD says to Tyre: 'Won't the islands shake at the sound of your fall, when the wounded groan, when the slaughter is made within you? ¹⁶Then all the princes of the sea will come down from their thrones, and lay aside their robes, and strip off their embroidered garments. They will clothe themselves with trembling. They will sit on the ground, and will tremble every moment, and be astonished at you. ¹⁷They will take up a lamentation over you, and tell you, "How you are destroyed, who were inhabited by seafaring men, the renowned city, who was strong in the sea, she and her inhabitants, who caused their terror to be on all who lived there!" ¹⁸Now the islands will tremble in the day of your fall. Yes, the islands that are in the sea will be dismayed at your departure.' ¹⁹"For the Lord GOD says: 'When I make you a desolate city, like the cities that are not inhabited, when I bring up the deep on you, and the great waters cover you, ²⁰then I will bring you down with those who descend into the pit, to the people of old time, and will make you dwell in the lower parts of the earth, in the places that are desolate of old, with those who go down to the pit, that you be not inhabited; and I will set glory in

the land of the living. ²¹I will make you a terror, and you will no more have any being. Though you are sought for, yet you will never be found again,' says the Lord GOD."

27The LORD's word came again to me, saying, ²"You, son of man, take up a lamentation over Tyre; ³and tell Tyre, 'You who dwell at the entry of the sea, who are the merchant of the peoples to many islands, the Lord GOD says: "You, Tyre, have said, 'I am perfect in beauty.' ⁴Your borders are in the heart of the seas. Your builders have perfected your beauty. ⁵They have made all your planks of cypress trees from Senir. They have taken a cedar from Lebanon to make a mast for you. ⁶They have made your oars of the oaks of Bashan. They have made your benches of ivory inlaid in cypress wood from the islands of Kittim. ⁷Your sail was of fine linen with embroidered work from Egypt, that it might be to you for a banner. Blue and purple from the islands of Elishah was your awning. ⁸The inhabitants of Sidon and Arvad were your rowers. Your wise men, Tyre, were in you. They were your pilots. ⁹The old men of Gebal and its wise men were your repairers of ship seams in you. All the ships of the sea with their mariners were in you to deal in your merchandise. ¹⁰"'"Persia, Lud, and Put were in your army, your men of war. They hung the shield and helmet in you. They showed your beauty. ¹¹The men of Arvad with your army were on your walls all around, and valiant men were in your towers. They hung their shields on your walls all around. They have perfected your beauty. ¹²"'"Tarshish was your merchant by reason of the multitude of all kinds of riches. They traded for your wares with silver, iron, tin, and lead. ¹³"'"Javan, Tubal, and Meshech were your traders. They traded the persons of men and vessels of bronze for your merchandise. ¹⁴"'"They of the house of Togarmah traded for your wares with horses, war horses, and mules. ¹⁵"'"The men of Dedan traded with you. Many islands were the market of your hand. They brought you horns of ivory and ebony in exchange. ¹⁶"'"Syria was your merchant by reason of the multitude of your handiworks. They traded for your wares with emeralds, purple, embroidered work, fine linen, coral, and rubies. ¹⁷"'"Judah and Eretz-Israel were your traders. They traded wheat of Minnith, confections, honey, oil, and balm for your merchandise. ¹⁸"'"Damascus was your merchant for the multitude of your handiworks by reason of the multitude of all kinds of riches, with the wine of Helbon, and white wool. ¹⁹"'"Vedan and Javan traded with yarn for your wares; wrought iron, cassia, and calamus were among your merchandise. ²⁰"'"Dedan was your merchant in precious saddle blankets for riding. ²¹"'"Arabia and all the princes of Kedar were your favorite dealers in lambs, rams, and goats. In these, they were your merchants. ²²"'"The traders of Sheba and Raamah were your traders. They traded for your wares with the best of all spices, all precious stones, and gold. ²³"'"Haran, Canneh,

Eden, the traders of Sheba, Asshur and Chilmad, were your traders. ²⁴These were your traders in choice wares, in wrappings of blue and embroidered work, and in cedar chests of rich clothing bound with cords, among your merchandise. ²⁵"'"The ships of Tarshish were your caravans for your merchandise. You were replenished and made very glorious in the heart of the seas. ²⁶Your rowers have brought you into great waters. The east wind has broken you in the heart of the seas. ²⁷Your riches, your wares, your merchandise, your mariners, your pilots, your repairers of ship seams, the dealers in your merchandise, and all your men of war who are in you, with all your company which is among you, will fall into the heart of the seas in the day of your ruin. ²⁸At the sound of the cry of your pilots, the pasture lands will shake. ²⁹All who handle the oars, the mariners and all the pilots of the sea, will come down from their ships. They will stand on the land, ³⁰and will cause their voice to be heard over you, and will cry bitterly. They will cast up dust on their heads. They will wallow in the ashes. ³¹They will make themselves bald for you, and clothe themselves with sackcloth. They will weep for you in bitterness of soul, with bitter mourning. ³²In their wailing they will take up a lamentation for you, and lament over you, saying, 'Who is there like Tyre, like her who is brought to silence in the middle of the sea?' ³³When your wares came from the seas, you filled many peoples. You enriched the kings of the earth with the multitude of your riches and of your merchandise. ³⁴In the time that you were broken by the seas, in the depths of the waters, your merchandise and all your company fell within you. ³⁵All the inhabitants of the islands are astonished at you, and their kings are horribly afraid. They are troubled in their face. ³⁶The merchants among the peoples hiss at you. You have come to a terrible end, and you will be no more.'"

28The LORD's word came again to me, saying, ²"Son of man, tell the prince of Tyre, 'The Lord GOD says: "Because your heart is lifted up, and you have said, 'I am a god, I sit in the seat of God, in the middle of the seas;' yet you are man, and no god, though you set your heart as the heart of a god— ³behold, you are wiser than Daniel. There is no secret that is hidden from you. ⁴By your wisdom and by your understanding you have gotten yourself riches, and have gotten gold and silver into your treasuries. ⁵By your great wisdom and by your trading you have increased your riches, and your heart is lifted up because of your riches—" ⁶"'"therefore the Lord GOD says: "Because you have set your heart as the heart of God, ⁷therefore, behold, I will bring strangers on you, the terrible of the nations. They will draw their swords against the beauty of your wisdom. They will defile your brightness. ⁸They will bring you down to the pit. You will die the death of those who are slain in the heart of the seas. ⁹Will you yet say before him who kills you, 'I am God'? But you are

man, and not God, in the hand of him who wounds you. ¹⁰You will die the death of the uncircumcised by the hand of strangers; for I have spoken it," says the Lord GOD.'"¹¹Moreover the LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹²"Son of man, take up a lamentation over the king of Tyre, and tell him, 'The Lord GOD says: "You were the seal of full measure, full of wisdom, and perfect in beauty. ¹³You were in Eden, the garden of God. Every precious stone adorned you: ruby, topaz, emerald, chrysolite, onyx, jasper, sapphire, ^{xv} turquoise, and beryl. Gold work of tambourines and of pipes was in you. They were prepared in the day that you were created. ¹⁴You were the anointed cherub who covers. Then I set you up on the holy mountain of God. You have walked up and down in the middle of the stones of fire. ¹⁵You were perfect in your ways from the day that you were created, until unrighteousness was found in you. ¹⁶By the abundance of your commerce, your insides were filled with violence, and you have sinned. Therefore I have cast you as profane out of God's mountain. I have destroyed you, covering cherub, from the middle of the stones of fire. ¹⁷Your heart was lifted up because of your beauty. You have corrupted your wisdom by reason of your splendor. I have cast you to the ground. I have laid you before kings, that they may see you. ¹⁸By the multitude of your iniquities, in the unrighteousness of your commerce, you have profaned your sanctuaries. Therefore I have brought out a fire from the middle of you. It has devoured you. I have turned you to ashes on the earth in the sight of all those who see you. ¹⁹All those who know you among the peoples will be astonished at you. You have become a terror, and you will exist no more.'"²⁰The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²¹"Son of man, set your face toward Sidon, and prophesy against it, ²²and say, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I am against you, Sidon. I will be glorified among you. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have executed judgments in her, and am sanctified in her. ²³For I will send pestilence into her, and blood into her streets. The wounded will fall within her, with the sword on her on every side. Then they will know that I am the LORD. ²⁴"²⁵"There will no longer be a pricking brier to the house of Israel, nor a hurting thorn of any that are around them that scorned them. Then they will know that I am the Lord GOD." ²⁵"The Lord GOD says: "When I have gathered the house of Israel from the peoples among whom they are scattered, and am shown as holy among them in the sight of the nations, then they will dwell in their own land which I gave to my servant Jacob. ²⁶They will dwell in it securely. Yes, they will build houses, plant vineyards, and will dwell securely when I have executed judgments on all those around them who have treated them with contempt. Then they will know that I am the LORD their God.'"

^{xv}or, lapis lazuli

²⁹In the tenth year, in the tenth month, on the twelfth day of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, set your face against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy against him and against all Egypt. ³Speak and say, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I am against you, Pharaoh king of Egypt, the great monster that lies in the middle of his rivers, that has said, 'My river is my own, and I have made it for myself.' ⁴I will put hooks in your jaws, and I will make the fish of your rivers stick to your scales. I will bring you up out of the middle of your rivers, with all the fish of your rivers which stick to your scales. ⁵I'll cast you out into the wilderness, you and all the fish of your rivers. You'll fall on the open field. You won't be brought together or gathered. I have given you for food to the animals of the earth and to the birds of the sky. ⁶"⁷All the inhabitants of Egypt will know that I am the LORD, because they have been a staff of reed to the house of Israel. ⁷When they took hold of you by your hand, you broke and tore all their shoulders. When they leaned on you, you broke and paralyzed all of their thighs." ⁸"Therefore the Lord GOD says: "Behold, I will bring a sword on you, and will cut off man and animal from you. ⁹The land of Egypt will be a desolation and a waste. Then they will know that I am the LORD. ¹⁰"¹¹"Because he has said, 'The river is mine, and I have made it,' ¹⁰therefore, behold, I am against you and against your rivers. I will make the land of Egypt an utter waste and desolation, from the tower of Seveh even to the border of Ethiopia. ¹¹No foot of man will pass through it, nor will any animal foot pass through it. It won't be inhabited for forty years. ¹²I will make the land of Egypt a desolation in the middle of the countries that are desolate. Her cities among the cities that are laid waste will be a desolation forty years. I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries." ¹³"For the Lord GOD says: "At the end of forty years I will gather the Egyptians from the peoples where they were scattered. ¹⁴I will reverse the captivity of Egypt, and will cause them to return into the land of Pathros, into the land of their birth. There they will be a lowly kingdom. ¹⁵It will be the lowest of the kingdoms. It won't lift itself up above the nations any more. I will diminish them so that they will no longer rule over the nations. ¹⁶It will no longer be the confidence of the house of Israel, bringing iniquity to memory, when they turn to look after them. Then they will know that I am the Lord GOD.'"¹⁷It came to pass in the twenty-seventh year, in the first month, in the first day of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹⁸"Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon caused his army to serve a great service against Tyre. Every head was made bald, and every shoulder was worn; yet he had no wages, nor did his army, from Tyre, for the service that he had served against it. ¹⁹Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I will give the land of Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar

king of Babylon. He will carry off her multitude, take her plunder, and take her prey. That will be the wages for his army. ²⁰I have given him the land of Egypt as his payment for which he served, because they worked for me,' says the Lord GOD. ²¹'In that day I will cause a horn to sprout for the house of Israel, and I will open your mouth among them. Then they will know that I am the LORD.'

30The LORD's word came again to me, saying, ²'Son of man, prophesy, and say, 'The Lord GOD says: "Wail, 'Alas for the day!' ³For the day is near, even the LORD's day is near. It will be a day of clouds, a time of the nations. ⁴A sword will come on Egypt, and anguish will be in Ethiopia, when the slain fall in Egypt. They take away her multitude, and her foundations are broken down. ⁵'"Ethiopia, Put, Lud, all the mixed people, Cub, and the children of the land that is allied with them, will fall with them by the sword." ⁶'The LORD says: "They also who uphold Egypt will fall. The pride of her power will come down. They will fall by the sword in it from the tower of Seveneh," says the Lord GOD. ⁷"They will be desolate in the middle of the countries that are desolate. Her cities will be among the cities that are wasted. ⁸They will know that I am the LORD when I have set a fire in Egypt, and all her helpers are destroyed. ⁹'"In that day messengers will go out from before me in ships to make the careless Ethiopians afraid. There will be anguish on them, as in the day of Egypt; for, behold, it comes." ¹⁰'The Lord GOD says: "I will also make the multitude of Egypt to cease, by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. ¹¹He and his people with him, the terrible of the nations, will be brought in to destroy the land. They will draw their swords against Egypt, and fill the land with the slain. ¹²I will make the rivers dry, and will sell the land into the hand of evil men. I will make the land desolate, and all that is therein, by the hand of foreigners. I, the LORD, have spoken it." ¹³'The Lord GOD says: "I will also destroy the idols, and I will cause the images to cease from Memphis. There will be no more a prince from the land of Egypt. I will put a fear in the land of Egypt. ¹⁴I will make Pathros desolate, and will set a fire in Zoan, and will execute judgments on No. ¹⁵I will pour my wrath on Sin, the stronghold of Egypt. I will cut off the multitude of No. ¹⁶I will set a fire in Egypt Sin will be in great anguish. No will be broken up. Memphis will have adversaries in the day-time. ¹⁷The young men of Aven and of Pibeseth will fall by the sword. They will go into captivity. ¹⁸At Tehaphnehes also the day will withdraw itself, when I break the yokes of Egypt there. The pride of her power will cease in her. As for her, a cloud will cover her, and her daughters will go into captivity. ¹⁹Thus I will execute judgments on Egypt. Then they will know that I am the LORD.''" ²⁰In the eleventh year, in the first month, in the seventh day of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²¹'Son

of man, I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt. Behold, it has not been bound up, to apply medicines, to put a bandage to bind it, that it may become strong to hold the sword. ²²Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt, and will break his arms, the strong arm, and that which was broken. I will cause the sword to fall out of his hand. ²³I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations, and will disperse them through the countries. ²⁴I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, and put my sword in his hand; but I will break the arms of Pharaoh, and he will groan before the king of Babylon with the groaning of a mortally wounded man. ²⁵I will hold up the arms of the king of Babylon, but the arms of Pharaoh will fall down. Then they will know that I am the LORD when I put my sword into the hand of the king of Babylon, and he stretches it out on the land of Egypt. ²⁶I will scatter the Egyptians among the nations and disperse them through the countries. Then they will know that I am the LORD.'

31In the eleventh year, in the third month, in the first day of the month, The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²'Son of man, tell Pharaoh king of Egypt and his multitude: 'Whom are you like in your greatness? ³Behold, the Assyrian was a cedar in Lebanon with beautiful branches, and with a forest-like shade, of high stature; and its top was among the thick boughs. ⁴The waters nourished it. The deep made it to grow. Its rivers ran all around its plantation. It sent out its channels to all the trees of the field. ⁵Therefore its stature was exalted above all the trees of the field; and its boughs were multiplied. Its branches became long by reason of many waters, when it spread them out. ⁶All the birds of the sky made their nests in its boughs. Under its branches, all the animals of the field gave birth to their young. All great nations lived under its shadow. ⁷Thus it was beautiful in its greatness, in the length of its branches; for its root was by many waters. ⁸The cedars in the garden of God could not hide it. The cypress trees were not like its branches. The pine trees were not like its branches; nor was any tree in the garden of God like it in its beauty. ⁹I made it beautiful by the multitude of its branches, so that all the trees of Eden, that were in the garden of God, envied it.' ¹⁰'Therefore thus said the Lord GOD: 'Because he is exalted in stature, and he has set his top among the thick branches, and his heart is lifted up in his height, ¹¹I will deliver him into the hand of the mighty one of the nations. He will surely deal with him. I have driven him out for his wickedness. ¹²Foreigners, the tyrants of the nations, have cut him off and have left him. His branches have fallen on the mountains and in all the valleys, and his boughs are broken by all the watercourses of the land. All the peoples of the earth have gone down from his shadow and have left him. ¹³All the birds of the sky will dwell on his ruin, and all

the animals of the field will be on his branches, ¹⁴to the end that none of all the trees by the waters exalt themselves in their stature, and don't set their top among the thick boughs. Their mighty ones don't stand up on their height, even all who drink water; for they are all delivered to death, to the lower parts of the earth, among the children of men, with those who go down to the pit.' ¹⁵"The Lord GOD says: 'In the day when he went down to Sheol, ^{xvi} I caused a mourning. I covered the deep for him, and I restrained its rivers. The great waters were stopped. I caused Lebanon to mourn for him, and all the trees of the field fainted for him. ¹⁶I made the nations to shake at the sound of his fall, when I cast him down to Sheol ^{xvii} with those who descend into the pit. All the trees of Eden, the choice and best of Lebanon, all that drink water, were comforted in the lower parts of the earth. ¹⁷They also went down into Sheol with him to those who are slain by the sword; yes, those who were his arm, who lived under his shadow in the middle of the nations. ¹⁸"To whom are you thus like in glory and in greatness among the trees of Eden? Yet you will be brought down with the trees of Eden to the lower parts of the earth. You will lie in the middle of the uncircumcised, with those who are slain by the sword. "This is Pharaoh and all his multitude,' says the Lord GOD."

32In the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, in the first day of the month, "the LORD's word came to me, saying, ²'Son of man, take up a lamentation over Pharaoh king of Egypt, and tell him, "You were likened to a young lion of the nations; yet you are as a monster in the seas. You broke out with your rivers, and troubled the waters with your feet, and fouled their rivers." ³The Lord GOD says: "I will spread out my net on you with a company of many peoples. They will bring you up in my net. ⁴I will leave you on the land. I will cast you out on the open field, and will cause all the birds of the sky to settle on you. I will satisfy the animals of the whole earth with you. ⁵I will lay your flesh on the mountains, and fill the valleys with your height. ⁶I will also water the land in which you swim with your blood, even to the mountains. The watercourses will be full of you. ⁷When I extinguish you, I will cover the heavens and make its stars dark. I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon won't give its light. ⁸I will make all the bright lights of the sky dark over you, and set darkness on your land," says the Lord GOD. ⁹"I will also trouble the hearts of many peoples, when I bring your destruction among the nations, into the countries which you have not known. ¹⁰Yes, I will make many peoples amazed at you, and their kings will be horribly afraid for you, when I brandish my sword before them. They will tremble at every moment, every man for his own life, in the day of your fall." ¹¹For

the Lord GOD says: "The sword of the king of Babylon will come on you. ¹²I will cause your multitude to fall by the swords of the mighty. They are all the ruthless of the nations. They will bring the pride of Egypt to nothing, and all its multitude will be destroyed. ¹³I will destroy also all its animals from beside many waters. The foot of man won't trouble them any more, nor will the hoofs of animals trouble them. ¹⁴Then I will make their waters clear, and cause their rivers to run like oil," says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵"When I make the land of Egypt desolate and waste, a land destitute of that of which it was full, when I strike all those who dwell therein, then they will know that I am the LORD. ¹⁶"This is the lamentation with which they will lament. The daughters of the nations will lament with this. They will lament with it over Egypt, and over all her multitude," says the Lord GOD." ¹⁷Also in the twelfth year, in the fifteenth day of the month, the LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹⁸"Son of man, wail for the multitude of Egypt, and cast them down, even her and the daughters of the famous nations, to the lower parts of the earth, with those who go down into the pit. ¹⁹Whom do you pass in beauty? Go down, and be laid with the uncircumcised. ²⁰They will fall among those who are slain by the sword. She is delivered to the sword. Draw her away with all her multitudes. ²¹The strong among the mighty will speak to him out of the middle of Sheol ^{xviii} with those who help him. They have gone down. The uncircumcised lie still, slain by the sword. ²²"Asshur is there with all her company. Her graves are all around her. All of them are slain, fallen by the sword, ²³whose graves are set in the uttermost parts of the pit, and her company is around her grave, all of them slain, fallen by the sword, who caused terror in the land of the living. ²⁴"There is Elam and all her multitude around her grave; all of them slain, fallen by the sword, who have gone down uncircumcised into the lower parts of the earth, who caused their terror in the land of the living, and have borne their shame with those who go down to the pit. ²⁵They have made Elam a bed among the slain with all her multitude. Her graves are around her, all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword; for their terror was caused in the land of the living, and they have borne their shame with those who go down to the pit. He is put among those who are slain. ²⁶"There is Meshech, Tubal, and all their multitude. Their graves are around them, all of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword; for they caused their terror in the land of the living. ²⁷They will not lie with the mighty who are fallen of the uncircumcised, who have gone down to Sheol with their weapons of war and have laid their swords under their heads. Their iniquities are on their bones; for they were the terror of the mighty in the land of the living. ²⁸"But you will be broken among the uncircumcised, and will lie with those who are slain by the sword. ²⁹"There is Edom,

^{xvi}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xvii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

^{xviii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

her kings, and all her princes, who in their might are laid with those who are slain by the sword. They will lie with the uncircumcised, and with those who go down to the pit. ³⁰“There are the princes of the north, all of them, and all the Sidonians, who have gone down with the slain. They are put to shame in the terror which they caused by their might. They lie uncircumcised with those who are slain by the sword, and bear their shame with those who go down to the pit. ³¹“Pharaoh will see them and will be comforted over all his multitude, even Pharaoh and all his army, slain by the sword,” says the Lord GOD. ³²“For I have put his terror in the land of the living. He will be laid among the uncircumcised, with those who are slain by the sword, even Pharaoh and all his multitude,” says the Lord GOD.

33The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, speak to the children of your people, and tell them, ‘When I bring the sword on a land, and the people of the land take a man from among them, and set him for their watchman, ³if, when he sees the sword come on the land, he blows the shofar and warns the people, ⁴then whoever hears the sound of the shofar and doesn’t heed the warning, if the sword comes and takes him away, his blood will be on his own head. ⁵He heard the sound of the shofar and didn’t take warning. His blood will be on him; whereas if he had heeded the warning, he would have delivered his soul. ⁶But if the watchman sees the sword come and doesn’t blow the shofar, and the people aren’t warned, and the sword comes and takes any person from among them, he is taken away in his iniquity, but his blood I will require at the watchman’s hand.’ ⁷“So you, son of man, I have set you a watchman to the house of Israel. Therefore hear the word from my mouth, and give them warnings from me. ⁸When I tell the wicked, ‘O wicked man, you will surely die,’ and you don’t speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man will die in his iniquity, but I will require his blood at your hand. ⁹Nevertheless, if you warn the wicked of his way to turn from it, and he doesn’t turn from his way; he will die in his iniquity, but you have delivered your soul. ¹⁰“You, son of man, tell the house of Israel: ‘You say this, “Our transgressions and our sins are on us, and we pine away in them. How then can we live?”’ ¹¹Tell them, “‘As I live,’ says the Lord GOD, “I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but that the wicked turn from his way and live. Turn, turn from your evil ways! For why will you die, house of Israel?”’ ¹²“You, son of man, tell the children of your people, ‘The righteousness of the righteous will not deliver him in the day of his disobedience. And as for the wickedness of the wicked, he will not fall by it in the day that he turns from his wickedness; neither will he who is righteous be able to live by it in the day that he sins. ¹³When I tell the righteous that he will surely live, if he trusts in his righteousness and commits iniquity, none of his righteous deeds will be remembered; but he will die in

his iniquity that he has committed. ¹⁴Again, when I say to the wicked, “You will surely die,” if he turns from his sin and does that which is lawful and right, ¹⁵if the wicked restore the pledge, give again that which he had taken by robbery, walk in the statutes of life, committing no iniquity, he will surely live. He will not die. ¹⁶None of his sins that he has committed will be remembered against him. He has done that which is lawful and right. He will surely live. ¹⁷“Yet the children of your people say, “The way of the Lord is not fair;” but as for them, their way is not fair. ¹⁸When the righteous turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, he will even die therein. ¹⁹When the wicked turns from his wickedness and does that which is lawful and right, he will live by it. ²⁰Yet you say, “The way of the Lord is not fair.” House of Israel, I will judge every one of you after his ways.” ²¹In the twelfth year of our captivity, in the tenth month, in the fifth day of the month, one who had escaped out of Jerusalem came to me, saying, “The city has been defeated!” ²²Now the LORD’s hand had been on me in the evening, before he who had escaped came; and he had opened my mouth until he came to me in the morning; and my mouth was opened, and I was no longer mute. ²³The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²⁴“Son of man, those who inhabit the waste places in Eretz-Israel speak, saying, ‘Abraham was one, and he inherited the land; but we are many. The land is given us for inheritance.’ ²⁵Therefore tell them, ‘The Lord GOD says: “You eat with the blood, and lift up your eyes to your idols, and shed blood. So should you possess the land? ²⁶You stand on your sword, you work abomination, and every one of you defiles his neighbor’s wife. So should you possess the land?”’ ²⁷“You shall tell them, ‘The Lord GOD says: “As I live, surely those who are in the waste places will fall by the sword. I will give whoever is in the open field to the animals to be devoured, and those who are in the strongholds and in the caves will die of the pestilence. ²⁸I will make the land a desolation and an astonishment. The pride of her power will cease. The mountains of Israel will be desolate, so that no one will pass through. ²⁹Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have made the land a desolation and an astonishment because of all their abominations which they have committed.”’ ³⁰“As for you, son of man, the children of your people talk about you by the walls and in the doors of the houses, and speak to one another, everyone to his brother, saying, ‘Please come and hear what the word is that comes out from the LORD.’ ³¹They come to you as the people come, and they sit before you as my people, and they hear your words, but don’t do them; for with their mouth they show much love, but their heart goes after their gain. ³²Behold, you are to them as a very lovely song of one who has a pleasant voice, and can play well on an instrument; for they hear your words, but they don’t do them. ³³“When this comes to pass—behold, it comes—then they will know that a

prophet has been among them.”

34The LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy, and tell them, even the shepherds, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Shouldn’t the shepherds feed the sheep? ³You eat the fat. You clothe yourself with the wool. You kill the fatlings, but you don’t feed the sheep. ⁴You haven’t strengthened the diseased. You haven’t healed that which was sick. You haven’t bound up that which was broken. You haven’t brought back that which was driven away. You haven’t sought that which was lost, but you have ruled over them with force and with rigor. ⁵They were scattered, because there was no shepherd. They became food to all the animals of the field, and were scattered. ⁶My sheep wandered through all the mountains and on every high hill. Yes, my sheep were scattered on all the surface of the earth. There was no one who searched or sought.” ⁷“Therefore, you shepherds, hear the LORD’s word: ⁸“As I live,” says the Lord GOD, “surely because my sheep became a prey, and my sheep became food to all the animals of the field, because there was no shepherd, and my shepherds didn’t search for my sheep, but the shepherds fed themselves, and didn’t feed my sheep, ⁹therefore, you shepherds, hear the LORD’s word!” ¹⁰The Lord GOD says: “Behold, I am against the shepherds. I will require my sheep at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the sheep. The shepherds won’t feed themselves any more. I will deliver my sheep from their mouth, that they may not be food for them.” ¹¹“For the Lord GOD says: “Behold, I myself, even I, will search for my sheep, and will seek them out. ¹²As a shepherd seeks out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered abroad, so I will seek out my sheep. I will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day. ¹³I will bring them out from the peoples, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them into their own land. I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, by the watercourses, and in all the inhabited places of the country. ¹⁴I will feed them with good pasture, and their fold will be on the mountains of the height of Israel. There they will lie down in a good fold. They will feed on rich pasture on the mountains of Israel. ¹⁵I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep, and I will cause them to lie down,” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁶“I will seek that which was lost, and will bring back that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick; but I will destroy the fat and the strong. I will feed them in justice.” ¹⁷“As for you, O my flock, the Lord GOD says: ‘Behold, I judge between sheep and sheep, the rams and the male goats. ¹⁸Does it seem a small thing to you to have fed on the good pasture, but you must tread down with your feet the residue of your pasture? And to have drunk of the

clear waters, but must you foul the residue with your feet? ¹⁹As for my sheep, they eat that which you have trodden with your feet, and they drink that which you have fouled with your feet.’ ²⁰“Therefore the Lord GOD says to them: ‘Behold, I, even I, will judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep. ²¹Because you thrust with side and with shoulder, and push all the diseased with your horns, until you have scattered them abroad, ²²therefore I will save my flock, and they will no more be a prey. I will judge between sheep and sheep. ²³I will set up one shepherd over them, and he will feed them, even my servant David. He will feed them, and he will be their shepherd. ²⁴I, the LORD, will be their God, and my servant David prince among them. I, the LORD, have spoken it. ²⁵“‘I will make with them a covenant of peace, and will cause evil animals to cease out of the land. They will dwell securely in the wilderness and sleep in the woods. ²⁶I will make them and the places around my hill a blessing. I will cause the shower to come down in its season. There will be showers of blessing. ²⁷The tree of the field will yield its fruit, and the earth will yield its increase, and they will be secure in their land. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have broken the bars of their yoke, and have delivered them out of the hand of those who made slaves of them. ²⁸They will no more be a prey to the nations, neither will the animals of the earth devour them; but they will dwell securely, and no one will make them afraid. ²⁹I will raise up to them a plantation for renown, and they will no more be consumed with famine in the land, and not bear the shame of the nations any more. ³⁰They will know that I, the LORD, their God am with them, and that they, the house of Israel, are my people, says the Lord GOD. ³¹You my sheep, the sheep of my pasture, are men, and I am your God,’ says the Lord GOD.”

35Moreover the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ²“Son of man, set your face against Mount Seir, and prophesy against it, ³and tell it, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Behold, I am against you, Mount Seir, and I will stretch out my hand against you. I will make you a desolation and an astonishment. ⁴I will lay your cities waste, and you will be desolate. Then you will know that I am the LORD. ⁵““Because you have had a perpetual hostility, and have given over the children of Israel to the power of the sword in the time of their calamity, in the time of the iniquity of the end, ⁶therefore, as I live,” says the Lord GOD, “I will prepare you for blood, and blood will pursue you. Since you have not hated blood, therefore blood will pursue you. ⁷Thus I will make Mount Seir an astonishment and a desolation. I will cut off from it him who passes through and him who returns. ⁸I will fill its mountains with its slain. The slain with the sword will fall in your hills and in your valleys and in all your watercourses. ⁹I will make you a perpetual desolation, and your cities will not be inhabited.

Then you will know that I am the LORD. ¹⁰“Because you have said, ‘These two nations and these two countries will be mine, and we will possess it,’ although the LORD was there, ¹¹therefore, as I live,” says the Lord GOD, “I will do according to your anger, and according to your envy which you have shown out of your hatred against them; and I will make myself known among them when I judge you. ¹²You will know that I, the LORD, have heard all your insults which you have spoken against the mountains of Israel, saying, ‘They have been laid desolate. They have been given to us to devour.’ ¹³You have magnified yourselves against me with your mouth, and have multiplied your words against me. I have heard it.” ¹⁴The Lord GOD says: “When the whole earth rejoices, I will make you desolate. ¹⁵As you rejoiced over the inheritance of the house of Israel because it was desolate, so I will do to you. You will be desolate, Mount Seir, and all Edom, even all of it. Then they will know that I am the LORD.”

36You, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel, and say, “You mountains of Israel, hear the LORD’s word. ²The Lord GOD says: ‘Because the enemy has said against you, “Aha!” and, “The ancient high places are ours in possession!”’ ³therefore prophesy, and say, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Because, even because they have made you desolate, and swallowed you up on every side, that you might be a possession to the residue of the nations, and you are taken up in the lips of talkers, and the evil report of the people;” ⁴therefore, you mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord GOD: The Lord GOD says to the mountains and to the hills, to the watercourses and to the valleys, to the desolate wastes and to the cities that are forsaken, which have become a prey and derision to the residue of the nations that are all around; ⁵therefore the Lord GOD says: “Surely in the fire of my jealousy I have spoken against the residue of the nations, and against all Edom, that have appointed my land to themselves for a possession with the joy of all their heart, with despite of soul, to cast it out for a prey.”’ ⁶Therefore prophesy concerning Eretz-Israel, and tell the mountains, the hills, the watercourses and the valleys, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Behold, I have spoken in my jealousy and in my wrath, because you have borne the shame of the nations.”’ ⁷Therefore the Lord GOD says: “I have sworn, ‘Surely the nations that are around you will bear their shame.’” ⁸““But you, mountains of Israel, you shall shoot out your branches and yield your fruit to my people Israel; for they are at hand to come. ⁹For, behold, I am for you, and I will come to you, and you will be tilled and sown. ¹⁰I will multiply men on you, all the house of Israel, even all of it. The cities will be inhabited and the waste places will be built. ¹¹I will multiply man and animal on you. They will increase and be fruitful. I will cause you to be inhabited as you were before, and you will do better than at your beginnings. Then you will know

that I am the LORD. ¹²Yes, I will cause men to walk on you, even my people Israel. They will possess you, and you will be their inheritance, and you will never again bereave them of their children.” ¹³“The Lord GOD says: “Because they say to you, ‘You are a devourer of men, and have been a bereaver of your nation;’ ¹⁴therefore you shall devour men no more, and not bereave your nation any more,” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁵“I won’t let you hear the shame of the nations any more. You won’t bear the reproach of the peoples any more, and you won’t cause your nation to stumble any more,” says the Lord GOD.” ¹⁶Moreover the LORD’s word came to me, saying, ¹⁷“Son of man, when the house of Israel lived in their own land, they defiled it by their ways and by their deeds. Their way before me was as the uncleanness of a woman in her impurity. ¹⁸Therefore I poured out my wrath on them for the blood which they had poured out on the land, and because they had defiled it with their idols. ¹⁹I scattered them among the nations, and they were dispersed through the countries. I judged them according to their way and according to their deeds. ²⁰When they came to the nations where they went, they profaned my holy name, in that men said of them, ‘These are the LORD’s people, and have left his land.’ ²¹But I had respect for my holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the nations where they went. ²²“Therefore tell the house of Israel, ‘The Lord GOD says: “I don’t do this for your sake, house of Israel, but for my holy name, which you have profaned among the nations where you went. ²³I will sanctify my great name, which has been profaned among the nations, which you have profaned among them. Then the nations will know that I am the LORD,” says the Lord GOD, “when I am proven holy in you before their eyes. ²⁴““For I will take you from among the nations and gather you out of all the countries, and will bring you into your own land. ²⁵I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you will be clean. I will cleanse you from all your filthiness and from all your idols. ²⁶I will also give you a new heart, and I will put a new spirit within you. I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you a heart of flesh. ²⁷I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes. You will keep my ordinances and do them. ²⁸You will dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers. You will be my people, and I will be your God. ²⁹I will save you from all your uncleanness. I will call for the grain and will multiply it, and lay no famine on you. ³⁰I will multiply the fruit of the tree and the increase of the field, that you may receive no more the reproach of famine among the nations. ³¹““Then you will remember your evil ways, and your deeds that were not good; and you will loathe yourselves in your own sight for your iniquities and for your abominations. ³²I don’t do this for your sake,” says the Lord GOD. “Let it be known to you. Be ashamed and confounded for your ways, house of Israel.” ³³“The Lord GOD says: “In

the day that I cleanse you from all your iniquities, I will cause the cities to be inhabited and the waste places will be built. ³⁴The land that was desolate will be tilled instead of being a desolation in the sight of all who passed by. ³⁵They will say, 'This land that was desolate has become like the garden of Eden. The waste, desolate, and ruined cities are fortified and inhabited.' ³⁶Then the nations that are left around you will know that I, the LORD, have built the ruined places and planted that which was desolate. I, the LORD, have spoken it, and I will do it." ³⁷"The Lord GOD says: "For this, moreover, I will be inquired of by the house of Israel, to do it for them: I will increase them with men like a flock. ³⁸As the flock for sacrifice, as the flock of Jerusalem in her appointed feasts, so the waste cities will be filled with flocks of men. Then they will know that I am the LORD.'"

37 The LORD's hand was on me, and he brought me out in the LORD's Spirit, and set me down in the middle of the valley; and it was full of bones. ²He caused me to pass by them all around; and behold, there were very many in the open valley, and behold, they were very dry. ³He said to me, "Son of man, can these bones live?" I answered, "Lord GOD, you know." ⁴Again he said to me, "Prophecy over these bones, and tell them, 'You dry bones, hear the LORD's word.' ⁵The Lord GOD says to these bones: "Behold, I will cause breath to enter into you, and you will live. ⁶I will lay sinews on you, and will bring up flesh on you, and cover you with skin, and put breath in you, and you will live. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'"⁷ So I prophesied as I was commanded. As I prophesied, there was a noise, and behold, there was an earthquake. Then the bones came together, bone to its bone. ⁸I saw, and, behold, there were sinews on them, and flesh came up, and skin covered them above; but there was no breath in them. ⁹Then he said to me, "Prophecy to the wind, prophecy, son of man, and tell the wind, 'The Lord GOD says: "Come from the four winds, breath, and breathe on these slain, that they may live.'"¹⁰ So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up on their feet, an exceedingly great army. ¹¹Then he said to me, "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. Behold, they say, 'Our bones are dried up, and our hope is lost. We are completely cut off.' ¹²Therefore prophecy, and tell them, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I will open your graves, and cause you to come up out of your graves, my people; and I will bring you into Eretz-Israel. ¹³You will know that I am the LORD, when I have opened your graves and caused you to come up out of your graves, my people. ¹⁴I will put my Spirit in you, and you will live. Then I will place you in your own land; and you will know that I, the LORD, have spoken it and performed it," says the LORD.'"¹⁵ The LORD's word came again to me, saying, ¹⁶"You, son of

man, take one stick and write on it, 'For Judah, and for the children of Israel his companions.' Then take another stick, and write on it, 'For Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all the house of Israel his companions.' ¹⁷Then join them for yourself to one another into one stick, that they may become one in your hand. ¹⁸"When the children of your people speak to you, saying, 'Won't you show us what you mean by these?' ¹⁹tell them, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel his companions; and I will put them with it, with the stick of Judah, and make them one stick, and they will be one in my hand. ²⁰The sticks on which you write will be in your hand before their eyes.'"²¹ Say to them, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I will take the children of Israel from among the nations where they have gone, and will gather them on every side, and bring them into their own land. ²²I will make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel. One king will be king to them all. They will no longer be two nations. They won't be divided into two kingdoms any more at all. ²³They won't defile themselves any more with their idols, nor with their detestable things, nor with any of their transgressions; but I will save them out of all their dwelling places in which they have sinned, and will cleanse them. So they will be my people, and I will be their God. ²⁴"My servant David will be king over them. They all will have one shepherd. They will also walk in my ordinances and observe my statutes, and do them. ²⁵They will dwell in the land that I have given to Jacob my servant, in which your fathers lived. They will dwell therein, they, and their children, and their children's children, forever. David my servant will be their prince forever. ²⁶Moreover I will make a covenant of peace with them. It will be an everlasting covenant with them. I will place them, multiply them, and will set my sanctuary among them forever more. ²⁷My tent also will be with them. I will be their God, and they will be my people. ²⁸The nations will know that I am the LORD who sanctifies Israel, when my sanctuary is among them forever more.'"

38 The LORD's word came to me, saying, ²"Son of man, set your face toward Gog, of the land of Magog, the prince of Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal, and prophecy against him, ³and say, 'The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I am against you, Gog, prince of Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal. ⁴I will turn you around, and put hooks into your jaws, and I will bring you out, with all your army, horses and horsemen, all of them clothed in full armor, a great company with buckler and shield, all of them handling swords; ⁵Persia, Cush, and Put with them, all of them with shield and helmet; ⁶Gomer, and all his hordes; the house of Togarmah in the uttermost parts of the north, and all his hordes—even many peoples with you. ⁷"Be prepared, yes, prepare yourself, you, and all your companies who are assembled to you, and be a

guard to them. ⁸After many days you will be visited. In the latter years you will come into the land that is brought back from the sword, that is gathered out of many peoples, on the mountains of Israel, which have been a continual waste; but it is brought out of the peoples and they will dwell securely, all of them. ⁹You will ascend. You will come like a storm. You will be like a cloud to cover the land, you and all your hordes, and many peoples with you.” ¹⁰“The Lord GOD says: “It will happen in that day that things will come into your mind, and you will devise an evil plan. ¹¹You will say, ‘I will go up to the land of unwallled villages. I will go to those who are at rest, who dwell securely, all of them dwelling without walls, and having neither bars nor gates, ¹²to take the plunder and to take prey; to turn your hand against the waste places that are inhabited, and against the people who are gathered out of the nations, who have gotten livestock and goods, who dwell in the middle of the earth.’ ¹³Sheba, Dedan, and the merchants of Tarshish, with all its young lions, will ask you, ‘Have you come to take the plunder? Have you assembled your company to take the prey, to carry away silver and gold, to take away livestock and goods, to take great plunder?’” ¹⁴“Therefore, son of man, prophesy, and tell Gog, ‘The Lord GOD says: “In that day when my people Israel dwells securely, will you not know it? ¹⁵You will come from your place out of the uttermost parts of the north, you, and many peoples with you, all of them riding on horses, a great company and a mighty army. ¹⁶You will come up against my people Israel as a cloud to cover the land. It will happen in the latter days that I will bring you against my land, that the nations may know me when I am sanctified in you, Gog, before their eyes.” ¹⁷“The Lord GOD says: “Are you he of whom I spoke in old time by my servants the prophets of Israel, who prophesied in those days for years that I would bring you against them? ¹⁸It will happen in that day, when Gog comes against Eretz-Israel,” says the Lord GOD, “that my wrath will come up into my nostrils. ¹⁹For in my jealousy and in the fire of my wrath I have spoken. Surely in that day there will be a great shaking in Eretz-Israel, ²⁰so that the fish of the sea, the birds of the sky, the animals of the field, all creeping things who creep on the earth, and all the men who are on the surface of the earth will shake at my presence. Then the mountains will be thrown down, the steep places will fall, and every wall will fall to the ground. ²¹I will call for a sword against him to all my mountains,” says the Lord GOD. “Every man’s sword will be against his brother. ²²I will enter into judgment with him with pestilence and with blood. I will rain on him, on his hordes, and on the many peoples who are with him, torrential rains with great hailstones, fire, and sulfur. ²³I will magnify myself and sanctify myself, and I will make myself known in the eyes of many nations. Then they will know that I am the LORD.”

³⁹“You, son of man, prophesy against Gog, and say, ‘The Lord GOD says: “Behold, I am against you, Gog, prince of Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal. ²I will turn you around, will lead you on, and will cause you to come up from the uttermost parts of the north; and I will bring you onto the mountains of Israel. ³I will strike your bow out of your left hand, and will cause your arrows to fall out of your right hand. ⁴You will fall on the mountains of Israel, you, and all your hordes, and the peoples who are with you. I will give you to the ravenous birds of every sort and to the animals of the field to be devoured. ⁵You will fall on the open field, for I have spoken it,” says the Lord GOD. ⁶“I will send a fire on Magog and on those who dwell securely in the islands. Then they will know that I am the LORD. ⁷““I will make my holy name known among my people Israel. I won’t allow my holy name to be profaned any more. Then the nations will know that I am the LORD, the Holy One in Israel. ⁸Behold, it comes, and it will be done,” says the Lord GOD. “This is the day about which I have spoken. ⁹““Those who dwell in the cities of Israel will go out and will make fires of the weapons and burn them, both the shields and the bucklers, the bows and the arrows, and the war clubs and the spears, and they will make fires with them for seven years; ¹⁰so that they will take no wood out of the field, and not cut down any out of the forests; for they will make fires with the weapons. They will plunder those who plundered them, and rob those who robbed them,” says the Lord GOD. ¹¹““It will happen in that day, that I will give to Gog a place for burial in Israel, the valley of those who pass through on the east of the sea; and it will stop those who pass through. They will bury Gog and all his multitude there, and they will call it ‘The valley of Hamon Gog’. ¹²““The house of Israel will be burying them for seven months, that they may cleanse the land. ¹³Yes, all the people of the land will bury them; and they will become famous in the day that I will be glorified,” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁴““They will set apart men of continual employment who will pass through the land. Those who pass through will go with those who bury those who remain on the surface of the land, to cleanse it. After the end of seven months they will search. ¹⁵Those who search through the land will pass through; and when anyone sees a man’s bone, then he will set up a sign by it, until the undertakers have buried it in the valley of Hamon Gog. ¹⁶Hamonah will also be the name of a city. Thus they will cleanse the land.”’ ¹⁷“You, son of man, the Lord GOD says: ‘Speak to the birds of every sort, and to every animal of the field, “Assemble yourselves, and come; gather yourselves on every side to my sacrifice that I sacrifice for you, even a great sacrifice on the mountains of Israel, that you may eat meat and drink blood. ¹⁸You shall eat the flesh of the mighty, and drink the blood of the princes of the earth, of rams, of lambs, and of goats, of bulls, all of them fatlings of Bashan. ¹⁹You shall eat fat until you are full,

and drink blood until you are drunk, of my sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you. ²⁰You shall be filled at my table with horses and charioteers, with mighty men, and with all men of war," says the Lord GOD. ²¹"I will set my glory among the nations. Then all the nations will see my judgment that I have executed, and my hand that I have laid on them. ²²So the house of Israel will know that I am the LORD their God, from that day and forward. ²³The nations will know that the house of Israel went into captivity for their iniquity, because they trespassed against me, and I hid my face from them; so I gave them into the hand of their adversaries, and they all fell by the sword. ²⁴I did to them according to their uncleanness and according to their transgressions. I hid my face from them. ²⁵"Therefore the Lord GOD says: 'Now I will reverse the captivity of Jacob and have mercy on the whole house of Israel. I will be jealous for my holy name. ²⁶They will forget their shame and all their trespasses by which they have trespassed against me, when they dwell securely in their land. No one will make them afraid ²⁷when I have brought them back from the peoples, gathered them out of their enemies' lands, and am shown holy among them in the sight of many nations. ²⁸They will know that I am the LORD their God, in that I caused them to go into captivity among the nations, and have gathered them to their own land. Then I will leave none of them captive any more. ²⁹I won't hide my face from them any more, for I have poured out my Spirit on the house of Israel,' says the Lord GOD."

40In the twenty-fifth year of our captivity, in the beginning of the year, in the tenth day of the month, in the fourteenth year after the city was struck, in the same day, the LORD's hand was on me, and he brought me there. ²In the visions of God he brought me into Eretz-Israel, and set me down on a very high mountain, on which was something like the frame of a city to the south. ³He brought me there; and, behold, there was a man whose appearance was like the appearance of bronze, with a line of flax in his hand and a measuring reed; and he stood in the gate. ⁴The man said to me, "Son of man, see with your eyes, and hear with your ears, and set your heart on all that I will show you; for you have been brought here so that I may show them to you. Declare all that you see to the house of Israel." ⁵Behold, there was a wall on the outside of the house all around, and in the man's hand a measuring reed six cubits ^{xix} long, of a cubit and a hand width each. So he measured the thickness of the building, one reed; and the height, one reed. ⁶Then he came to the gate which looks toward the east, and went up its steps. He measured the

threshold of the gate, one reed wide; and the other threshold, one reed wide. ⁷Every lodge was one reed long and one reed wide. Between the lodges was five cubits. The threshold of the gate by the porch of the gate toward the house was one reed. ⁸He measured also the porch of the gate toward the house, one reed. ⁹Then he measured the porch of the gate, eight cubits; and its posts, two cubits; and the porch of the gate was toward the house. ¹⁰The side rooms of the gate eastward were three on this side, and three on that side. The three of them were of one measure. The posts had one measure on this side and on that side. ¹¹He measured the width of the opening of the gate, ten cubits; and the length of the gate, thirteen cubits; ¹²and a border before the lodges, one cubit on this side, and a border, one cubit on that side; and the side rooms, six cubits on this side, and six cubits on that side. ¹³He measured the gate from the roof of the one side room to the roof of the other, a width of twenty-five cubits, door against door. ¹⁴He also made posts, sixty cubits; and the court reached to the posts, around the gate. ¹⁵From the forefront of the gate at the entrance to the forefront of the inner porch of the gate were fifty cubits. ¹⁶There were closed windows to the side rooms, and to their posts within the gate all around, and likewise to the arches. Windows were around inward. Palm trees were on each post. ¹⁷Then he brought me into the outer court. Behold, there were rooms and a pavement made for the court all around. Thirty rooms were on the pavement. ¹⁸The pavement was by the side of the gates, corresponding to the length of the gates, even the lower pavement. ¹⁹Then he measured the width from the forefront of the lower gate to the forefront of the inner court outside, one hundred cubits, both on the east and on the north. ²⁰He measured the length and width of the gate of the outer court which faces toward the north. ²¹The lodges of it were three on this side and three on that side. Its posts and its arches were the same as the measure of the first gate: its length was fifty cubits, and the width twenty-five cubits. ²²Its windows, its arches, and its palm trees were the same as the measure of the gate which faces toward the east. They went up to it by seven steps. Its arches were before them. ²³There was a gate to the inner court facing the other gate, on the north and on the east. He measured one hundred cubits from gate to gate. ²⁴He led me toward the south; and behold, there was a gate toward the south. He measured its posts and its arches according to these measurements. ²⁵There were windows in it and in its arches all around, like the other windows: the length was fifty cubits, and the width twenty-five cubits. ²⁶There were seven steps to go up to it, and its arches were before them. It had palm trees, one on this side, and another on that side, on its posts. ²⁷There was a gate to the inner court toward the south. He measured one hundred cubits from gate to gate toward the south. ²⁸Then he brought me to the inner court by

^{xix}A normal cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A handbreadth is about 4.3 inches or 11 centimeters, so the long cubit described here would be about 22.3 inches or 57 centimeters long. Thus, a 6 long cubit measuring reed would have been about 3 yards 26.6 inches or about 3.42 meters long.

the south gate. He measured the south gate according to these measurements; ²⁹with its lodges, its posts, and its arches, according to these measurements. There were windows in it and in its arches all around. It was fifty cubits long, and twenty-five cubits wide. ³⁰There were arches all around, twenty-five cubits long and five cubits wide. ³¹Its arches were toward the outer court. Palm trees were on its posts. The ascent to it had eight steps. ³²He brought me into the inner court toward the east. He measured the gate according to these measurements; ³³with its lodges, its posts, and its arches, according to these measurements. There were windows in it and in its arches all around. It was fifty cubits long, and twenty-five cubits wide. ³⁴Its arches were toward the outer court. Palm trees were on its posts on this side and on that side. The ascent to it had eight steps. ³⁵He brought me to the north gate, and he measured it according to these measurements— ³⁶its lodges, its posts, and its arches. There were windows in it all around. The length was fifty cubits and the width twenty-five cubits. ³⁷Its posts were toward the outer court. Palm trees were on its posts on this side and on that side. The ascent to it had eight steps. ³⁸A room with its door was by the posts at the gates. They washed the burnt offering there. ³⁹In the porch of the gate were two tables on this side and two tables on that side, on which to kill the burnt offering, the sin offering, and the trespass offering. ⁴⁰On the one side outside, as one goes up to the entry of the gate toward the north, were two tables; and on the other side, which belonged to the porch of the gate, were two tables. ⁴¹Four tables were on this side, and four tables on that side, by the side of the gate: eight tables, on which they killed the sacrifices. ⁴²There were four cut stone tables for the burnt offering, a cubit and a half long, a cubit and a half wide, and one cubit high. They laid the instruments with which they killed the burnt offering and the sacrifice on them. ⁴³The hooks, a hand width long, were fastened within all around. The meat of the offering was on the tables. ⁴⁴Outside of the inner gate were rooms for the singers in the inner court, which was at the side of the north gate. They faced toward the south. One at the side of the east gate faced toward the north. ⁴⁵He said to me, “This room, which faces toward the south, is for the priests who perform the duty of the house. ⁴⁶The room which faces toward the north is for the priests who perform the duty of the altar. These are the sons of Zadok, who from among the sons of Levi come near to the LORD to minister to him.” ⁴⁷He measured the court, one hundred cubits long and one hundred cubits wide, square. The altar was before the house. ⁴⁸Then he brought me to the porch of the house, and measured each post of the porch, five cubits on this side, and five cubits on that side. The width of the gate was three cubits on this side and three cubits on that side. ⁴⁹The length of the porch was twenty cubits and the width eleven cubits, even by the steps by

which they went up to it. There were pillars by the posts, one on this side, and another on that side.

⁴¹He brought me to the nave and measured the posts, six cubits wide on the one side and six cubits wide on the other side, which was the width of the tent. ²The width of the entrance was ten cubits, ^{xx} and the sides of the entrance were five cubits on the one side, and five cubits on the other side. He measured its length, forty cubits, and the width, twenty cubits. ³Then he went inward and measured each post of the entrance, two cubits; and the entrance, six cubits; and the width of the entrance, seven cubits. ⁴He measured its length, twenty cubits, and the width, twenty cubits, before the nave. He said to me, “This is the most holy place.” ⁵Then he measured the wall of the house, six cubits; and the width of every side room, four cubits, all around the house on every side. ⁶The side rooms were in three stories, one over another, and thirty in each story. They entered into the wall which belonged to the house for the side rooms all around, that they might be supported and not penetrate the wall of the house. ⁷The side rooms were wider on the higher levels, because the walls were narrower at the higher levels. Therefore the width of the house increased upward; and so one went up from the lowest level to the highest through the middle level. ⁸I saw also that the house had a raised base all around. The foundations of the side rooms were a full reed of six great cubits. ⁹The thickness of the outer wall of the side rooms was five cubits. That which was left was the place of the side rooms that belonged to the house. ¹⁰Between the rooms was a width of twenty cubits around the house on every side. ¹¹The doors of the side rooms were toward an open area that was left, one door toward the north, and another door toward the south. The width of the open area was five cubits all around. ¹²The building that was before the separate place at the side toward the west was seventy cubits wide; and the wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, and its length ninety cubits. ¹³So he measured the temple, one hundred cubits long; and the separate place, and the building, with its walls, one hundred cubits long; ¹⁴also the width of the face of the temple, and of the separate place toward the east, one hundred cubits. ¹⁵He measured the length of the building before the separate place which was at its back, and its galleries on the one side and on the other side, one hundred cubits from the inner temple, and the porches of the court, ¹⁶the thresholds, and the closed windows, and the galleries around on their three stories, opposite the threshold, with wood ceilings all around, and from the ground up to the windows, (now the windows were covered), ¹⁷to the space above the door, even to the inner house, and outside, and by all the wall all around inside and outside, by measure. ¹⁸It was

^{xx}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

made with cherubim and palm trees. A palm tree was between cherub and cherub, and every cherub had two faces,¹⁹ so that there was the face of a man toward the palm tree on the one side, and the face of a young lion toward the palm tree on the other side. It was made like this through all the house all around.²⁰ Cherubim and palm trees were made from the ground to above the door. The wall of the temple was like this.²¹ The door posts of the nave were squared. As for the face of the nave, its appearance was as the appearance of the temple.²² The altar was of wood, three cubits high, and its length two cubits. Its corners, its base, and its walls were of wood. He said to me, "This is the table that is before the LORD."²³ The temple and the sanctuary had two doors.²⁴ The doors had two leaves each, two turning leaves: two for the one door, and two leaves for the other.²⁵ There were made on them, on the doors of the nave, cherubim and palm trees, like those made on the walls. There was a threshold of wood on the face of the porch outside.²⁶ There were closed windows and palm trees on the one side and on the other side, on the sides of the porch. This is how the side rooms of the temple and the thresholds were arranged.

42 Then he brought me out into the outer court, the way toward the north. Then he brought me into the room that was opposite the separate place, and which was opposite the building toward the north.² Facing the length of one hundred cubits^{xxi} was the north door, and the width was fifty cubits.³ Opposite the twenty cubits which belonged to the inner court, and opposite the pavement which belonged to the outer court, was gallery against gallery in the three stories.⁴ Before the rooms was a walk of ten cubits' width inward, a way of one cubit; and their doors were toward the north.⁵ Now the upper rooms were shorter; for the galleries took away from these more than from the lower and the middle in the building.⁶ For they were in three stories, and they didn't have pillars as the pillars of the courts. Therefore the uppermost was set back more than the lowest and the middle from the ground.⁷ The wall that was outside by the side of the rooms, toward the outer court before the rooms, was fifty cubits long.⁸ For the length of the rooms that were in the outer court was fifty cubits. Behold, those facing the temple were one hundred cubits.⁹ From under these rooms was the entry on the east side, as one goes into them from the outer court.¹⁰ In the thickness of the wall of the court toward the east, before the separate place, and before the building, there were rooms.¹¹ The way before them was like the appearance of the rooms which were toward the north. Their length and width were the same. All their exits had the same arrangement and doors.¹² Like the doors of the rooms that were toward the south was a door at the head

of the way, even the way directly before the wall toward the east, as one enters into them.¹³ Then he said to me, "The north rooms and the south rooms, which are opposite the separate place, are the holy rooms, where the priests who are near to the LORD shall eat the most holy things. There they shall lay the most holy things, with the meal offering, the sin offering, and the trespass offering; for the place is holy."¹⁴ When the priests enter in, then they shall not go out of the holy place into the outer court until they lay their garments in which they minister there; for they are holy. Then they shall put on other garments, and shall approach that which is for the people."¹⁵ Now when he had finished measuring the inner house, he brought me out by the way of the gate which faces toward the east, and measured it all around.¹⁶ He measured on the east side with the measuring reed five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed all around.¹⁷ He measured on the north side five hundred reeds with the measuring reed all around.¹⁸ He measured on the south side five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.¹⁹ He turned about to the west side, and measured five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.²⁰ He measured it on the four sides. It had a wall around it, the length five hundred cubits, and the width five hundred cubits, to make a separation between that which was holy and that which was common.

43 Afterward he brought me to the gate, even the gate that looks toward the east.² Behold, the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the east. His voice was like the sound of many waters; and the earth was illuminated with his glory.³ It was like the appearance of the vision which I saw, even according to the vision that I saw when I came to destroy the city; and the visions were like the vision that I saw by the river Chebar; and I fell on my face.⁴ The LORD's glory came into the house by the way of the gate which faces toward the east.⁵ The Spirit took me up and brought me into the inner court; and behold, the LORD's glory filled the house.⁶ I heard one speaking to me out of the house, and a man stood by me.⁷ He said to me, "Son of man, this is the place of my throne and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell among the children of Israel forever. The house of Israel will no more defile my holy name, neither they nor their kings, by their prostitution and by the dead bodies of their kings in their high places;⁸ in their setting of their threshold by my threshold and their door post beside my door post. There was a wall between me and them; and they have defiled my holy name by their abominations which they have committed. Therefore I have consumed them in my anger.⁹ Now let them put away their prostitution, and the dead bodies of their kings far from me. Then I will dwell among them forever."¹⁰ "You, son of man, show the house to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities; and let them measure the pattern."¹¹ If they are

^{xxi}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

ashamed of all that they have done, make known to them the form of the house, its fashion, its exits, its entrances, its structure, all its ordinances, all its forms, and all its laws; and write it in their sight, that they may keep the whole form of it, and all its ordinances, and do them. ¹²“This is the law of the house. On the top of the mountain the whole limit around it shall be most holy. Behold, this is the law of the house. ¹³“These are the measurements of the altar by cubits (the cubit ^{xxii} is a cubit and a hand width): the bottom shall be a cubit, and the width a cubit, and its border around its edge a span; ^{xxiii} and this shall be the base of the altar. ¹⁴From the bottom on the ground to the lower ledge shall be two cubits, and the width one cubit; and from the lesser ledge to the greater ledge shall be four cubits, and the width a cubit. ¹⁵The upper altar shall be four cubits; and from the altar hearth and upward there shall be four horns. ¹⁶The altar hearth shall be twelve cubits long by twelve wide, square in its four sides. ¹⁷The ledge shall be fourteen cubits long by fourteen wide in its four sides; and the border about it shall be half a cubit; and its bottom shall be a cubit around; and its steps shall look toward the east.” ¹⁸He said to me, “Son of man, the Lord GOD says: ‘These are the ordinances of the altar in the day when they make it, to offer burnt offerings on it, and to sprinkle blood on it. ¹⁹You shall give to the Levitical priests who are of the offspring of Zadok, who are near to me, to minister to me,’ says the Lord GOD, ‘a young bull for a sin offering. ²⁰You shall take of its blood and put it on its four horns, and on the four corners of the ledge, and on the border all around. You shall cleanse it and make atonement for it that way. ²¹You shall also take the bull of the sin offering, and it shall be burned in the appointed place of the house, outside of the sanctuary. ²²“On the second day you shall offer a male goat without defect for a sin offering; and they shall cleanse the altar, as they cleansed it with the bull. ²³When you have finished cleansing it, you shall offer a young bull without defect and a ram out of the flock without defect. ²⁴You shall bring them near to the LORD, and the priests shall cast salt on them, and they shall offer them up for a burnt offering to the LORD. ²⁵“Seven days you shall prepare every day a goat for a sin offering. They shall also prepare a young bull and a ram out of the flock, without defect. ²⁶Seven days shall they make atonement for the altar and purify it. So shall they consecrate it. ²⁷When they have accomplished the days, it shall be that on the eighth day and onward, the priests shall make your burnt offerings on the altar and your peace offerings. Then I will accept you,’ says the Lord GOD.”

^{xxii}A normal cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A hand width is about 4.3 inches or 11 cm.

^{xxiii}A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.)

⁴⁴Then he brought me back by the way of the outer gate of the sanctuary, which looks toward the east; and it was shut. ²The LORD said to me, “This gate shall be shut. It shall not be opened, no man shall enter in by it; for the LORD, the God of Israel, has entered in by it. Therefore it shall be shut. ³As for the prince, he shall sit in it as prince to eat bread before the LORD. He shall enter by the way of the porch of the gate, and shall go out the same way.” ⁴Then he brought me by the way of the north gate before the house; and I looked, and behold, the LORD's glory filled the LORD's house; so I fell on my face. ⁵The LORD said to me, “Son of man, mark well, and see with your eyes, and hear with your ears all that I tell you concerning all the ordinances of the LORD's house and all its laws; and mark well the entrance of the house, with every exit of the sanctuary. ⁶You shall tell the rebellious, even the house of Israel, ‘The Lord GOD says: “You house of Israel, let that be enough of all your abominations, ⁷in that you have brought in foreigners, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in my sanctuary, to profane it, even my house, when you offer my bread, the fat and the blood; and they have broken my covenant, to add to all your abominations. ⁸You have not performed the duty of my holy things; but you have set performers of my duty in my sanctuary for yourselves.” ⁹The Lord GOD says, “No foreigner, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter into my sanctuary, of any foreigners who are among the children of Israel. ¹⁰““But the Levites who went far from me when Israel went astray, who went astray from me after their idols, they will bear their iniquity. ¹¹Yet they shall be ministers in my sanctuary, having oversight at the gates of the house, and ministering in the house. They shall kill the burnt offering and the sacrifice for the people, and they shall stand before them to minister to them. ¹²Because they ministered to them before their idols, and became a stumbling block of iniquity to the house of Israel, therefore I have lifted up my hand against them,” says the Lord GOD, “and they will bear their iniquity. ¹³They shall not come near to me, to execute the office of priest to me, nor to come near to any of my holy things, to the things that are most holy; but they will bear their shame and their abominations which they have committed. ¹⁴Yet I will make them performers of the duty of the house, for all its service and for all that will be done therein. ¹⁵““But the Levitical priests, the sons of Zadok, who performed the duty of my sanctuary when the children of Israel went astray from me, shall come near to me to minister to me. They shall stand before me to offer to me the fat and the blood,” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁶“They shall enter into my sanctuary, and they shall come near to my table, to minister to me, and they shall keep my instruction. ¹⁷““It will be that when they enter in at the gates of the inner court, they shall be clothed with linen garments. No wool shall come on them while they minister

in the gates of the inner court, and within. ¹⁸They shall have linen turbans on their heads, and shall have linen trousers on their waists. They shall not clothe themselves with anything that makes them sweat. ¹⁹When they go out into the outer court, even into the outer court to the people, they shall put off their garments in which they minister and lay them in the holy rooms. They shall put on other garments, that they not sanctify the people with their garments. ²⁰““They shall not shave their heads, or allow their locks to grow long. They shall only cut off the hair of their heads. ²¹None of the priests shall drink wine when they enter into the inner court. ²²They shall not take for their wives a widow, or her who is put away; but they shall take virgins of the offspring of the house of Israel, or a widow who is the widow of a priest. ²³They shall teach my people the difference between the holy and the common, and cause them to discern between the unclean and the clean. ²⁴““In a controversy they shall stand to judge. They shall judge it according to my ordinances. They shall keep my laws and my statutes in all my appointed feasts. They shall make my Sabbaths holy. ²⁵““They shall go in to no dead person to defile themselves; but for father, or for mother, or for son, or for daughter, for brother, or for sister who has had no husband, they may defile themselves. ²⁶After he is cleansed, they shall reckon to him seven days. ²⁷In the day that he goes into the sanctuary, into the inner court, to minister in the sanctuary, he shall offer his sin offering,” says the Lord GOD. ²⁸““They shall have an inheritance: I am their inheritance; and you shall give them no possession in Israel. I am their possession. ²⁹They shall eat the meal offering, and the sin offering, and the trespass offering; and every devoted thing in Israel shall be theirs. ³⁰The first of all the first fruits of every thing, and every offering of everything, of all your offerings, shall be for the priest. You shall also give to the priests the first of your dough, to cause a blessing to rest on your house. ³¹The priests shall not eat of anything that dies of itself or is torn, whether it is bird or animal.

⁴⁵““Moreover, when you divide by lot the land for inheritance, you shall offer an offering to the LORD, a holy portion of the land. The length shall be the length of twenty-five thousand reeds, and the width shall be ten thousand. It shall be holy in all its border all around. ²Of this there shall be a five hundred by five hundred square for the holy place, and fifty cubits ^{xxiv} for its pasture lands all around. ³Of this measure you shall measure a length of twenty-five thousand, and a width of ten thousand. In it shall be the sanctuary, which is most holy. ⁴It is a holy portion of the land; it shall be for the priests, the ministers of the sanctuary, who come near to minister to the LORD. It shall be a place for their houses and a holy place

for the sanctuary. ⁵Twenty-five thousand cubits in length and ten thousand in width shall be for the Levites, the ministers of the house, as a possession for themselves, for twenty rooms. ⁶““You shall appoint the possession of the city five thousand cubits wide and twenty-five thousand long, side by side with the offering of the holy portion. It shall be for the whole house of Israel. ⁷““What is for the prince shall be on the one side and on the other side of the holy allotment and of the possession of the city, in front of the holy allotment and in front of the possession of the city, on the west side westward, and on the east side eastward, and in length corresponding to one of the portions, from the west border to the east border. ⁸In the land it shall be to him for a possession in Israel. My princes shall no more oppress my people, but they shall give the land to the house of Israel according to their tribes.” ⁹“The Lord GOD says: “Enough you, princes of Israel! Remove violence and plunder, and execute justice and righteousness! Stop dispossessing my people!” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁰“You shall have just balances, a just ephah, ^{xxv} and a just bath. ¹¹The ephah and the bath shall be of one measure, that the bath may contain one tenth of a homer, ^{xxvi} and the ephah one tenth of a homer. Its measure shall be the same as the homer. ¹²The shekel ^{xxvii} shall be twenty gerahs. ^{xxviii} Twenty shekels plus twenty-five shekels plus fifteen shekels shall be your mina. ^{xxix} ¹³““This is the offering that you shall offer: the sixth part of an ephah from a homer of wheat, and you shall give the sixth part of an ephah from a homer of barley, ¹⁴and the set portion of oil, of the bath of oil, one tenth of a bath out of the cor, which is ten baths, even a homer (for ten baths are a homer), ^{xxx} ¹⁵and one lamb of the flock out of two hundred, from the well-watered pastures of Israel—for a meal offering, for a burnt offering, and for peace offerings, to make atonement for them,” says the Lord GOD. ¹⁶“All the people of the land shall give to this offering for the prince in Israel. ¹⁷It shall be the prince’s part to give the burnt offerings, the meal offerings, and the drink offerings, in the feasts, and on the new moons, and on the Sabbaths, in all the appointed feasts of the house of Israel. He shall prepare the sin offering, the meal offering, the burnt offering, and the peace offerings, to make atonement for the house of Israel.” ¹⁸“The Lord GOD says: “In the first month, on the first day of the month, you shall take a young bull without defect, and you shall cleanse the sanctuary. ¹⁹The priest shall take of the blood of the sin offering and put it on the door posts of the house, and on the four corners of

^{xxv}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxvi}1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

^{xxvii}1 shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{xxviii}1 gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains

^{xxix}1 mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds.

^{xxx}1 cor is the same as 1 homer in volume, and is about 211 liters, 55.9 gallons, or 6 bushels. 1 bath is about 21.1 liters, 5.59 gallons, or 2.4 pecks.

^{xxiv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

the ledge of the altar, and on the posts of the gate of the inner court. ²⁰So you shall do on the seventh day of the month for everyone who errs, and for him who is simple. So you shall make atonement for the house. ²¹““In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, you shall have the Passover, a feast of seven days; unleavened bread shall be eaten. ²²On that day the prince shall prepare for himself and for all the people of the land a bull for a sin offering. ²³The seven days of the feast he shall prepare a burnt offering to the LORD, seven bulls and seven rams without defect daily the seven days; and a male goat daily for a sin offering. ²⁴He shall prepare a meal offering, an ephah ^{xxxv} for a bull, an ephah for a ram, and a hin ^{xxxvi} of oil to an ephah. ²⁵““In the seventh month, on the fifteenth day of the month, during the feast, he shall do like that for seven days. He shall make the same provision for sin offering, the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the oil.”

46“The Lord GOD says: “The gate of the inner court that looks toward the east shall be shut the six working days; but on the Sabbath day it shall be opened, and on the day of the new moon it shall be opened. ²The prince shall enter by the way of the porch of the gate outside, and shall stand by the post of the gate; and the priests shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, and he shall worship at the threshold of the gate. Then he shall go out, but the gate shall not be shut until the evening. ³The people of the land shall worship at the door of that gate before the LORD on the Sabbaths and on the new moons. ⁴The burnt offering that the prince shall offer to the LORD shall be on the Sabbath day, six lambs without defect and a ram without defect; ⁵and the meal offering shall be an ephah for the ram, and the meal offering for the lambs as he is able to give, and a hin ^{xxxvii} of oil to an ephah. ^{xxxviii} ⁶On the day of the new moon it shall be a young bull without defect, six lambs, and a ram. They shall be without defect. ⁷He shall prepare a meal offering: an ephah for the bull, and an ephah for the ram, and for the lambs according as he is able, and a hin of oil to an ephah. ⁸When the prince enters, he shall go in by the way of the porch of the gate, and he shall go out by its way. ⁹““But when the people of the land come before the LORD in the appointed feasts, he who enters by the way of the north gate to worship shall go out by the way of the south gate; and he who enters by the way of the south gate shall go out by the way of the north gate. He shall not return by the way of the gate by which he came in, but shall go out straight before him. ¹⁰The prince shall go in with them when they go in. When they go out, he shall go out. ¹¹““In the feasts and in the appointed holidays, the

meal offering shall be an ephah ^{xxxv} for a bull, and an ephah for a ram, and for the lambs as he is able to give, and a hin of oil to an ephah. ¹²When the prince prepares a free will offering, a burnt offering or peace offerings as a free will offering to the LORD, one shall open for him the gate that looks toward the east; and he shall prepare his burnt offering and his peace offerings, as he does on the Sabbath day. Then he shall go out; and after his going out one shall shut the gate. ¹³““You shall prepare a lamb a year old without defect for a burnt offering to the LORD daily. Morning by morning you shall prepare it. ¹⁴You shall prepare a meal offering with it morning by morning, the sixth part of an ephah, ^{xxxvi} and the third part of a hin of oil to moisten the fine flour; a meal offering to the LORD continually by a perpetual ordinance. ¹⁵Thus they shall prepare the lamb, the meal offering, and the oil, morning by morning, for a continual burnt offering.” ¹⁶“The Lord GOD says: “If the prince gives a gift to any of his sons, it is his inheritance. It shall belong to his sons. It is their possession by inheritance. ¹⁷But if he gives of his inheritance a gift to one of his servants, it shall be his to the year of liberty; then it shall return to the prince; but as for his inheritance, it shall be for his sons. ¹⁸Moreover the prince shall not take of the people’s inheritance, to thrust them out of their possession. He shall give inheritance to his sons out of his own possession, that my people not each be scattered from his possession.”” ¹⁹Then he brought me through the entry, which was at the side of the gate, into the holy rooms for the priests, which looked toward the north. Behold, there was a place on the back part westward. ²⁰He said to me, “This is the place where the priests shall boil the trespass offering and the sin offering, and where they shall bake the meal offering, that they not bring them out into the outer court, to sanctify the people.” ²¹Then he brought me out into the outer court and caused me to pass by the four corners of the court; and behold, in every corner of the court there was a court. ²²In the four corners of the court there were courts enclosed, forty cubits ^{xxxvii} long and thirty wide. These four in the corners were the same size. ²³There was a wall around in them, around the four, and boiling places were made under the walls all around. ²⁴Then he said to me, “These are the boiling houses, where the ministers of the house shall boil the sacrifice of the people.”

47He brought me back to the door of the temple; and behold, waters flowed out from under the threshold of the temple eastward, for the front of the temple faced toward the east. The waters came down from underneath, from the right side of the temple, on the south of the altar.

^{xxxv}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{xxxvi}1 A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

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^{xxxvii}1 A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

²Then he brought me out by the way of the gate northward, and led me around by the way outside to the outer gate, by the way of the gate that looks toward the east. Behold, waters ran out on the right side. ³When the man went out eastward with the line in his hand, he measured one thousand cubits, ^{xxxviii} and he caused me to pass through the waters, waters that were to the ankles. ⁴Again he measured one thousand, and caused me to pass through the waters, waters that were to the knees. Again he measured one thousand, and caused me to pass through waters that were to the waist. ⁵Afterward he measured one thousand; and it was a river that I could not pass through, for the waters had risen, waters to swim in, a river that could not be walked through. ⁶He said to me, "Son of man, have you seen this?" Then he brought me and caused me to return to the bank of the river. ⁷Now when I had returned, behold, on the bank of the river were very many trees on the one side and on the other. ⁸Then he said to me, "These waters flow out toward the eastern region and will go down into the Arabah. Then they will go toward the sea and flow into the sea which will be made to flow out; and the waters will be healed. ⁹It will happen that every living creature which swarms, in every place where the rivers come, will live. Then there will be a very great multitude of fish; for these waters have come there, and the waters of the sea will be healed, and everything will live wherever the river comes. ¹⁰It will happen that fishermen will stand by it. From En Gedi even to En Eglaim will be a place for the spreading of nets. Their fish will be after their kinds, as the fish of the great sea, exceedingly many. ¹¹But its swamps marshes will not be healed. They will be given up to salt. ¹²By the river banks, on both sides, will grow every tree for food, whose leaf won't wither, neither will its fruit fail. It will produce new fruit every month, because its waters issue out of the sanctuary. Its fruit will be for food, and its leaf for healing." ¹³The Lord GOD says: "This shall be the border by which you shall divide the land for inheritance according to the twelve tribes of Israel. Joseph shall have two portions. ¹⁴You shall inherit it, one as well as another; for I swore to give it to your fathers. This land will fall to you for inheritance. ¹⁵"This shall be the border of the land: "On the north side, from the great sea, by the way of Hethlon, to the entrance of Zedad; ¹⁶Hamath, Berothah, Sibram (which is between the border of Damascus and the border of Hamath), to Hazer Hatticon, which is by the border of Hauran. ¹⁷The border from the sea shall be Hazar Enon at the border of Damascus; and on the north northward is the border of Hamath. This is the north side. ¹⁸"The east side, between Hauran, Damascus, Gilead, and Eretz-Israel, shall be the Jordan; from the north border to the east sea you shall measure. This is the east side. ¹⁹"The south side south-

ward shall be from Tamar as far as the waters of Meriboth Kadesh, to the brook, to the great sea. This is the south side southward. ²⁰"The west side shall be the great sea, from the south border as far as opposite the entrance of Hamath. This is the west side. ²¹"So you shall divide this land to yourselves according to the tribes of Israel. ²²You shall divide it by lot for an inheritance to you and to the aliens who live among you, who will father children among you. Then they shall be to you as the native-born among the children of Israel. They shall have inheritance with you among the tribes of Israel. ²³In whatever tribe the stranger lives, there you shall give him his inheritance," says the Lord GOD.

⁴⁸"Now these are the names of the tribes: From the north end, beside the way of Hethlon to the entrance of Hamath, Hazar Enan at the border of Damascus, northward beside Hamath (and they shall have their sides east and west), Dan, one portion. ²"By the border of Dan, from the east side to the west side, Asher, one portion. ³"By the border of Asher, from the east side even to the west side, Naphtali, one portion. ⁴"By the border of Naphtali, from the east side to the west side, Manasseh, one portion. ⁵"By the border of Manasseh, from the east side to the west side, Ephraim, one portion. ⁶"By the border of Ephraim, from the east side even to the west side, Reuben, one portion. ⁷"By the border of Reuben, from the east side to the west side, Judah, one portion. ⁸"By the border of Judah, from the east side to the west side, shall be the offering which you shall offer, twenty-five thousand reeds in width, and in length as one of the portions, from the east side to the west side; and the sanctuary shall be in the middle of it. ⁹"The offering that you shall offer to the LORD shall be twenty-five thousand reeds in length, and ten thousand in width. ¹⁰For these, even for the priests, shall be the holy offering: toward the north twenty-five thousand in length, and toward the west ten thousand in width, and toward the east ten thousand in width, and toward the south twenty-five thousand in length; and the sanctuary of the LORD shall be in the middle of it. ¹¹It shall be for the priests who are sanctified of the sons of Zadok, who have kept my instruction, who didn't go astray when the children of Israel went astray, as the Levites went astray. ¹²It shall be to them an offering from the offering of the land, a most holy thing, by the border of the Levites. ¹³"Alongside the border of the priests, the Levites shall have twenty-five thousand cubits in length and ten thousand in width. All the length shall be twenty-five thousand, and the width ten thousand. ¹⁴They shall sell none of it, nor exchange it, nor shall the first fruits of the land be alienated, for it is holy to the LORD. ¹⁵"The five thousand cubits that are left in the width, in front of the twenty-five thousand, shall be for common use, for the city, for dwelling and for pasture lands; and the city shall be in the middle of

^{xxxviii} A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

it. ¹⁶These shall be its measurements: the north side four thousand and five hundred, and the south side four thousand and five hundred, and on the east side four thousand and five hundred, and the west side four thousand and five hundred. ¹⁷The city shall have pasture lands: toward the north two hundred fifty, and toward the south two hundred fifty, and toward the east two hundred fifty, and toward the west two hundred fifty. ¹⁸The remainder of the length, alongside the holy offering, shall be ten thousand eastward and ten thousand westward; and it shall be alongside the holy offering. Its increase shall be for food to those who labor in the city. ¹⁹Those who labor in the city, out of all the tribes of Israel, shall cultivate it. ²⁰All the offering shall be a square of twenty-five thousand by twenty-five thousand. You shall offer it as a holy offering, with the possession of the city. ²¹“The remainder shall be for the prince, on the one side and on the other of the holy offering and of the possession of the city; in front of the twenty-five thousand of the offering toward the east border, and westward in front of the twenty-five thousand toward the west border, alongside the portions, it shall be for the prince. The holy offering and the sanctuary of the house shall be in the middle of it. ²²Moreover, from the possession of the Levites, and from the possession of the city, being in the middle of that which is the prince’s, between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin, shall be for the prince. ²³“As for the rest of the tribes: from the east side to the west side, Benjamin, one portion. ²⁴“By the border of Benjamin, from the east side to the west side, Simeon, one portion. ²⁵“By the border of Simeon, from the east side to the west side, Issachar, one portion. ²⁶“By the border of Issachar, from the east side to the west side, Zebulun, one portion. ²⁷“By the border of Zebulun, from the east side to the west side, Gad, one portion. ²⁸“By the border of Gad, at the south side southward, the border shall be even from Tamar to the waters of Meribath Kadesh, to the brook, to the great sea. ²⁹“This is the land which you shall divide by lot to the tribes of Israel for inheritance, and these are their several portions, says the Lord GOD. ³⁰“These are the exits of the city: On the north side four thousand five hundred reeds by measure; ³¹and the gates of the city shall be named after the tribes of Israel, three gates northward: the gate of Reuben, one; the gate of Judah, one; the gate of Levi, one. ³²“At the east side four thousand five hundred reeds, and three gates: even the gate of Joseph, one; the gate of Benjamin, one; the gate of Dan, one. ³³“At the south side four thousand five hundred reeds by measure, and three gates: the gate of Simeon, one; the gate of Issachar, one; the gate of Zebulun, one. ³⁴“At the west side four thousand five hundred reeds, with their three gates: the gate of Gad, one; the gate of Asher, one; the gate of Naphtali, one. ³⁵“It shall be eighteen thousand reeds in circumference; and the name of the city from that day shall be, ‘The LORD is there.’

Daniel

1In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim king of Judah, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to Jerusalem and besieged it. ²The Lord ⁱ gave Jehoiakim king of Judah into his hand, with some of the vessels of the house of God; ⁱⁱ and he carried them into the land of Shinar to the house of his god. He brought the vessels into the treasure house of his god. ³The king spoke to Ashpenaz, the master of his eunuchs, that he should bring in some of the children of Israel, even of the royal offspring ⁱⁱⁱ and of the nobles: ⁴youths in whom was no defect, but well-favored, skillful in all wisdom, endowed with knowledge, understanding science, and who had the ability to stand in the king's palace; and that he should teach them the learning and the language of the Kasdim. ⁵The king appointed for them a daily portion of the king's delicacies and of the wine which he drank, and that they should be nourished three years, that at its end they should stand before the king. ⁶Now among these of the children of Judah were Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah. ⁷The prince of the eunuchs gave names to them: to Daniel he gave the name Belteshazzar; to Hananiah, Shadrach; to Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah, Abednego. ⁸But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the king's delicacies, nor with the wine which he drank. Therefore he requested of the prince of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself. ⁹Now God made Daniel find kindness and compassion in the sight of the prince of the eunuchs. ¹⁰The prince of the eunuchs said to Daniel, "I fear my lord the king, who has appointed your food and your drink. For why should he see your faces worse looking than the youths who are of your own age? Then you would endanger my head with the king." ¹¹Then Daniel said to the steward whom the prince of the eunuchs had appointed over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah: ¹²"Test your servants, I beg you, ten days; and let them give us vegetables to eat and water to drink. ¹³Then let our faces be examined before you, and the face of the youths who eat of the king's delicacies; and as you see, deal with your servants." ¹⁴So he listened to them in this matter, and tested them for ten

days. ¹⁵At the end of ten days, their faces appeared fairer and they were fatter in flesh than all the youths who ate of the king's delicacies. ¹⁶So the steward took away their delicacies and the wine that they were given to drink, and gave them vegetables. ¹⁷Now as for these four youths, God gave them knowledge and skill in all learning and wisdom; and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams. ¹⁸At the end of the days which the king had appointed for bringing them in, the prince of the eunuchs brought them in before Nebuchadnezzar. ¹⁹The king talked with them; and among them all was found no one like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah. Therefore stood they before the king. ²⁰In every matter of wisdom and understanding concerning which the king inquired of them, he found them ten times better than all the magicians and enchanters who were in all his realm. ²¹Daniel continued even to the first year of King Cyrus.

2In the second year of the reign of Nebuchadnezzar, Nebuchadnezzar dreamed dreams; and his spirit was troubled, and his sleep went from him. ²Then the king commanded that the magicians, the enchanters, the sorcerers, and the Kasdim be called to tell the king his dreams. So they came in and stood before the king. ³The king said to them, "I have dreamed a dream, and my spirit is troubled to know the dream." ⁴Then the Kasdim spoke to the king in the Syrian language, "O king, live forever! Tell your servants the dream, and we will show the interpretation." ⁵The king answered the Kasdim, "The thing has gone from me. If you don't make known to me the dream and its interpretation, you will be cut in pieces, and your houses will be made a dunghill. ⁶But if you show the dream and its interpretation, you will receive from me gifts, rewards, and great honor. Therefore show me the dream and its interpretation." ⁷They answered the second time and said, "Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will show the interpretation." ⁸The king answered, "I know of a certainty that you are trying to gain time, because you see the thing has gone from me. ⁹But if you don't make known to me the dream, there is but one law for you; for you have prepared lying and corrupt words to speak before me, until the situation changes. Therefore tell me the dream, and I will know that you can show me its inter-

ⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱor, seed

pretation.” ¹⁰The Kasdians answered the king and said, “There is not a man on the earth who can show the king’s matter, because no king, lord, or ruler has asked such a thing of any magician, enchanter, or Chaldean. ¹¹It is a rare thing that the king requires, and there is no other who can show it before the king except the gods, whose dwelling is not with flesh.” ¹²Because of this, the king was angry and very furious, and commanded that all the wise men of Babylon be destroyed. ¹³So the decree went out, and the wise men were to be slain. They sought Daniel and his companions to be slain. ¹⁴Then Daniel returned answer with counsel and prudence to Arioch the captain of the king’s guard, who had gone out to kill the wise men of Babylon. ¹⁵He answered Arioch the king’s captain, “Why is the decree so urgent from the king?” Then Arioch made the thing known to Daniel. ¹⁶Daniel went in, and desired of the king that he would appoint him a time, and he would show the king the interpretation. ¹⁷Then Daniel went to his house and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions: ¹⁸that they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret, that Daniel and his companions would not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon. ¹⁹Then the secret was revealed to Daniel in a vision of the night. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven. ²⁰Daniel answered, “Blessed be the name of God forever and ever; for wisdom and might are his. ²¹He changes the times and the seasons. He removes kings and sets up kings. He gives wisdom to the wise, and knowledge to those who have understanding. ²²He reveals the deep and secret things. He knows what is in the darkness, and the light dwells with him. ²³I thank you and praise you, O God of my fathers, who have given me wisdom and might, and have now made known to me what we desired of you; for you have made known to us the king’s matter.” ²⁴Therefore Daniel went in to Arioch, whom the king had appointed to destroy the wise men of Babylon. He went and said this to him: “Don’t destroy the wise men of Babylon. Bring me in before the king, and I will show to the king the interpretation.” ²⁵Then Arioch brought in Daniel before the king in haste, and said this to him: “I have found a man of the children of the captivity of Judah who will make known to the king the interpretation.” ²⁶The king answered Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, “Are you able to make known to me the dream which I have seen, and its interpretation?” ²⁷Daniel answered before the king, and said, “The secret which the king has demanded can’t be shown to the king by wise men, enchanters, magicians, or soothsayers; ²⁸but there is a God in heaven who reveals secrets, and he has made known to King Nebuchadnezzar what will be in the latter days. Your dream and the visions of your head on your bed are these: ²⁹“As for you, O king, your thoughts came on your bed, what should happen hereafter; and he who reveals secrets has made known to you what will hap-

pen. ³⁰But as for me, this secret is not revealed to me for any wisdom that I have more than any living, but to the intent that the interpretation may be made known to the king, and that you may know the thoughts of your heart. ³¹“You, O king, saw, and behold, ^{iv} a great image. This image, which was mighty, and whose brightness was excellent, stood before you; and its appearance was terrifying. ³²As for this image, its head was of fine gold, its breast and its arms of silver, its belly and its thighs of bronze, ³³its legs of iron, its feet part of iron and part of clay. ³⁴You saw until a stone was cut out without hands, which struck the image on its feet that were of iron and clay, and broke them in pieces. ³⁵Then the iron, the clay, the bronze, the silver, and the gold were broken in pieces together, and became like the chaff of the summer threshing floors. The wind carried them away, so that no place was found for them. The stone that struck the image became a great mountain and filled the whole earth. ³⁶“This is the dream; and we will tell its interpretation before the king. ³⁷You, O king, are king of kings, to whom the God of heaven has given the kingdom, the power, the strength, and the glory. ³⁸Wherever the children of men dwell, he has given the animals of the field and the birds of the sky into your hand, and has made you rule over them all. You are the head of gold. ³⁹“After you, another kingdom will arise that is inferior to you; and another third kingdom of bronze, which will rule over all the earth. ⁴⁰The fourth kingdom will be strong as iron, because iron breaks in pieces and subdues all things; and as iron that crushes all these, it will break in pieces and crush. ⁴¹Whereas you saw the feet and toes, part of potters’ clay and part of iron, it will be a divided kingdom; but there will be in it of the strength of the iron, because you saw the iron mixed with miry clay. ⁴²As the toes of the feet were part of iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom will be partly strong and partly brittle. ⁴³Whereas you saw the iron mixed with miry clay, they will mingle themselves with the seed of men; but they won’t cling to one another, even as iron does not mix with clay. ⁴⁴“In the days of those kings the God of heaven will set up a kingdom which will never be destroyed, nor will its sovereignty be left to another people; but it will break in pieces and consume all these kingdoms, and it will stand forever. ⁴⁵Because you saw that a stone was cut out of the mountain without hands, and that it broke in pieces the iron, the bronze, the clay, the silver, and the gold, the great God has made known to the king what will happen hereafter. The dream is certain, and its interpretation sure.” ⁴⁶Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell on his face, worshiped Daniel, and commanded that they should offer an offering and sweet odors to him. ⁴⁷The king answered to Daniel, and said, “Of a truth your God is the God of gods, and the Lord of kings, and a revealer

^{iv}“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

of secrets, since you have been able to reveal this secret.”⁴⁸Then the king made Daniel great and gave him many great gifts, and made him rule over the whole province of Babylon and to be chief governor over all the wise men of Babylon. ⁴⁹Daniel requested of the king, and he appointed Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego over the affairs of the province of Babylon, but Daniel was in the king’s gate.

3Nebuchadnezzar the king made an image of gold, whose height was sixty cubits ^v and its width six cubits. He set it up in the plain of Dura, in the province of Babylon. ²Then Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to gather together the local governors, the deputies, and the governors, the judges, the treasurers, the counselors, the sheriffs, and all the rulers of the provinces, to come to the dedication of the image which Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up. ³Then the local governors, the deputies, and the governors, the judges, the treasurers, the counselors, the sheriffs, and all the rulers of the provinces were gathered together to the dedication of the image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up; and they stood before the image that Nebuchadnezzar had set up. ⁴Then the herald cried aloud, “To you it is commanded, peoples, nations, and languages, ⁵that whenever you hear the sound of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music, you fall down and worship the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king has set up. ⁶Whoever doesn’t fall down and worship shall be cast into the middle of a burning fiery furnace the same hour.” ⁷Therefore at that time, when all the peoples heard the sound of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music, all the peoples, the nations, and the languages fell down and worshiped the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had set up. ⁸Therefore at that time certain Kasdim came near and brought accusation against the Jews. ⁹They answered Nebuchadnezzar the king, “O king, live for ever! ¹⁰You, O king, have made a decree that every man who hears the sound of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music shall fall down and worship the golden image; ¹¹and whoever doesn’t fall down and worship shall be cast into the middle of a burning fiery furnace. ¹²There are certain Jews whom you have appointed over the affairs of the province of Babylon: Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. These men, O king, have not respected you. They don’t serve your gods, and don’t worship the golden image which you have set up.” ¹³Then Nebuchadnezzar in rage and fury commanded that Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego be brought. Then these men were brought before the king. ¹⁴Nebuchadnezzar answered them, “Is it true, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, that you don’t serve my gods and you don’t worship the golden image which I have set up? ¹⁵Now if you are ready whenever you hear the sound

of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music to fall down and worship the image which I have made, good; but if you don’t worship, you shall be cast the same hour into the middle of a burning fiery furnace. Who is that god who will deliver you out of my hands?” ¹⁶Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego answered the king, “Nebuchadnezzar, we have no need to answer you in this matter. ¹⁷If it happens, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace; and he will deliver us out of your hand, O king. ¹⁸But if not, let it be known to you, O king, that we will not serve your gods or worship the golden image which you have set up.” ¹⁹Then Nebuchadnezzar was full of fury, and the form of his appearance was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. He spoke, and commanded that they should heat the furnace seven times more than it was usually heated. ²⁰He commanded certain mighty men who were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace. ²¹Then these men were bound in their pants, their tunics, and their mantles, and their other clothes, and were cast into the middle of the burning fiery furnace. ²²Therefore because the king’s commandment was urgent and the furnace exceedingly hot, the flame of the fire killed those men who took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. ²³These three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, fell down bound into the middle of the burning fiery furnace. ²⁴Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was astonished and rose up in haste. He spoke and said to his counselors, “Didn’t we cast three men bound into the middle of the fire?” They answered the king, “True, O king.” ²⁵He answered, “Look, I see four men loose, walking in the middle of the fire, and they are unharmed. The appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods.” ²⁶Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to the mouth of the burning fiery furnace. He spoke and said, “Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, you servants of the Most High God, come out, and come here!” Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego came out of the middle of the fire. ²⁷The local governors, the deputies, and the governors, and the king’s counselors, being gathered together, saw these men, that the fire had no power on their bodies. The hair of their head wasn’t singed. Their pants weren’t changed. The smell of fire wasn’t even on them. ²⁸Nebuchadnezzar spoke and said, “Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who has sent his angel and delivered his servants who trusted in him, and have changed the king’s word, and have yielded their bodies, that they might not serve nor worship any god except their own God. ²⁹Therefore I make a decree that every people, nation, and language which speak anything evil against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill, because there is no other god who is able to deliver like this.” ³⁰Then the king promoted Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego in

^vA cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

the province of Babylon.

⁴Nebuchadnezzar the king, to all the peoples, nations, and languages, who dwell in all the earth: Peace be multiplied to you. ²It has seemed good to me to show the signs and wonders that the Most High God has worked toward me. ³How great are his signs! How mighty are his wonders! His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom. His dominion is from generation to generation. ⁴I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at rest in my house, and flourishing in my palace. ⁵I saw a dream which made me afraid; and the thoughts on my bed and the visions of my head troubled me. ⁶Therefore I made a decree to bring in all the wise men of Babylon before me, that they might make known to me the interpretation of the dream. ⁷Then the magicians, the enchanters, the Kasdim, and the soothsayers came in; and I told them the dream, but they didn't make known to me its interpretation. ⁸But at last, Daniel came in before me, whose name was Belteshazzar according to the name of my god, and in whom is the spirit of the holy gods. I told the dream before him, saying, ⁹"Belteshazzar, master of the magicians, because I know that the spirit of the holy gods is in you and no secret troubles you, tell me the visions of my dream that I have seen, and its interpretation. ¹⁰These were the visions of my head on my bed: I saw, and behold, a tree in the middle of the earth; and its height was great. ¹¹The tree grew and was strong. Its height reached to the sky and its sight to the end of all the earth. ¹²Its leaves were beautiful, and it had much fruit, and in it was food for all. The animals of the field had shade under it, and the birds of the sky lived in its branches, and all flesh was fed from it. ¹³"I saw in the visions of my head on my bed, and behold, a holy watcher came down from the sky. ¹⁴He cried aloud and said this: 'Cut down the tree, and cut off its branches! Shake off its leaves and scatter its fruit! Let the animals get away from under it and the birds from its branches. ¹⁵Nevertheless leave the stump of its roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and bronze, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of the sky. Let his portion be with the animals in the grass of the earth. ¹⁶Let his heart be changed from man's, and let an animal's heart be given to him. Then let seven times pass over him. ¹⁷"The sentence is by the decree of the watchers and the demand by the word of the holy ones, to the intent that the living may know that the Most High rules in the kingdom of men, and gives it to whomever he will, and sets up over it the lowest of men.' ¹⁸"This dream I, King Nebuchadnezzar, have seen; and you, Belteshazzar, declare the interpretation, because all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to make known to me the interpretation; but you are able, for the spirit of the holy gods is in you." ¹⁹Then Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, was stricken mute for a while, and his thoughts troubled him. The king answered, "Belteshazzar, don't let the dream or

the interpretation, trouble you." Belteshazzar answered, "My lord, may the dream be for those who hate you, and its interpretation to your adversaries. ²⁰The tree that you saw, which grew and was strong, whose height reached to the sky and its sight to all the earth; ²¹whose leaves were beautiful and its fruit plentiful, and in it was food for all; under which the animals of the field lived, and on whose branches the birds of the sky had their habitation— ²²it is you, O king, that have grown and become strong; for your greatness has grown, and reaches to the sky, and your dominion to the end of the earth. ²³"Whereas the king saw a holy watcher coming down from the sky and saying, 'Cut down the tree, and destroy it; nevertheless leave the stump of its roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and bronze, in the tender grass of the field, and let it be wet with the dew of the sky. Let his portion be with the animals of the field, until seven times pass over him.' ²⁴"This is the interpretation, O king, and it is the decree of the Most High, which has come on my lord the king: ²⁵You will be driven from men and your dwelling shall be with the animals of the field. You will be made to eat grass as oxen, and will be wet with the dew of the sky, and seven times shall pass over you, until you know that the Most High rules in the kingdom of men, and gives it to whomever he will. ²⁶Whereas it was commanded to leave the stump of the roots of the tree, your kingdom shall be sure to you after you know that Heavens rules. ²⁷Therefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable to you, and break off your sins by righteousness, and your iniquities by showing mercy to the poor. Perhaps there may be a lengthening of your tranquility." ²⁸All this came on the King Nebuchadnezzar. ²⁹At the end of twelve months he was walking in the royal palace of Babylon. ³⁰The king spoke and said, "Is not this great Babylon, which I have built for the royal dwelling place by the might of my power and for the glory of my majesty?" ³¹While the word was in the king's mouth, a voice came from the sky, saying, "O King Nebuchadnezzar, to you it is spoken: 'The kingdom has departed from you. ³²You shall be driven from men, and your dwelling shall be with the animals of the field. You shall be made to eat grass like oxen. Seven times shall pass over you, until you know that the Most High rules in the kingdom of men, and gives it to whomever he will.'" ³³This was fulfilled the same hour on Nebuchadnezzar. He was driven from men and ate grass like oxen; and his body was wet with the dew of the sky until his hair had grown like eagles' feathers, and his nails like birds' claws. ³⁴At the end of the days I, Nebuchadnezzar, lifted up my eyes to heaven, and my understanding returned to me; and I blessed the Most High, and I praised and honored him who lives forever, for his dominion is an everlasting dominion, and his kingdom from generation to generation. ³⁵All the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing; and he does according to his will in the army of heaven, and

among the inhabitants of the earth; and no one can stop his hand, or ask him, "What are you doing?" ³⁶At the same time my understanding returned to me; and for the glory of my kingdom, my majesty and brightness returned to me. My counselors and my lords sought me; and I was established in my kingdom, and excellent greatness was added to me. ³⁷Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise and extol and honor the King of heaven; for all his works are truth, and his ways justice; and those who walk in pride he is able to abase.

⁵Belshazzar the king made a great feast to a thousand of his lords, and drank wine before the thousand. ²Belshazzar, while he tasted the wine, commanded that the golden and silver vessels which Nebuchadnezzar his father had taken out of the temple which was in Jerusalem be brought to him, that the king and his lords, his wives and his concubines, might drink from them. ³Then they brought the golden vessels that were taken out of the temple of God's house which was at Jerusalem; and the king and his lords, his wives and his concubines, drank from them. ⁴They drank wine, and praised the gods of gold, and of silver, of bronze, of iron, of wood, and of stone. ⁵In the same hour, the fingers of a man's hand came out and wrote near the lamp stand on the plaster of the wall of the king's palace. The king saw the part of the hand that wrote. ⁶Then the king's face was changed in him, and his thoughts troubled him; and the joints of his thighs were loosened, and his knees struck one against another. ⁷The king cried aloud to bring in the enchanters, the Kasdim, and the soothsayers. The king spoke and said to the wise men of Babylon, "Whoever reads this writing and shows me its interpretation shall be clothed with purple, and have a chain of gold about his neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom." ⁸Then all the king's wise men came in; but they could not read the writing, and couldn't make known to the king the interpretation. ⁹Then King Belshazzar was greatly troubled, and his face was changed in him, and his lords were perplexed. ¹⁰The queen by reason of the words of the king and his lords came into the banquet house. The queen spoke and said, "O king, live forever; don't let your thoughts trouble you, nor let your face be changed. ¹¹There is a man in your kingdom in whom is the spirit of the holy gods; and in the days of your father, light and understanding and wisdom, like the wisdom of the gods, were found in him. The king, Nebuchadnezzar, your father—yes, the king, your father—made him master of the magicians, enchanters, Kasdim, and soothsayers, ¹²because an excellent spirit, knowledge, understanding, interpreting of dreams, showing of dark sentences, and dissolving of doubts were found in the same Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar. Now let Daniel be called, and he will show the interpretation." ¹³Then Daniel was brought in before the king. The king spoke and said to Daniel,

"Are you that Daniel of the children of the captivity of Judah, whom the king my father brought out of Judah?" ¹⁴I have heard of you, that the spirit of the gods is in you and that light, understanding, and excellent wisdom are found in you. ¹⁵Now the wise men, the enchanters, have been brought in before me, that they should read this writing, and make known to me its interpretation; but they could not show the interpretation of the thing. ¹⁶But I have heard of you, that you can give interpretations and dissolve doubts. Now if you can read the writing and make known to me its interpretation, you shall be clothed with purple, and have a chain of gold around your neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom." ¹⁷Then Daniel answered before the king, "Let your gifts be to yourself, and give your rewards to another. Nevertheless, I will read the writing to the king, and make known to him the interpretation. ¹⁸"To you, king, the Most High God gave Nebuchadnezzar your father the kingdom, and greatness, and glory, and majesty. ¹⁹Because of the greatness that he gave him, all the peoples, nations, and languages trembled and feared before him. He killed whom he wanted to, and he kept alive whom he wanted to. He raised up whom he wanted to, and he put down whom he wanted to. ²⁰But when his heart was lifted up, and his spirit was hardened so that he dealt proudly, he was deposed from his kingly throne, and they took his glory from him. ²¹He was driven from the sons of men, and his heart was made like the animals', and his dwelling was with the wild donkeys. He was fed with grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of the sky, until he knew that the Most High God rules in the kingdom of men, and that he sets up over it whomever he will. ²²"You, his son, Belshazzar, have not humbled your heart, though you knew all this, ²³but have lifted up yourself against the Lord of heaven; and they have brought the vessels of his house before you, and you and your lords, your wives, and your concubines, have drunk wine from them. You have praised the gods of silver and gold, of bronze, iron, wood, and stone, which don't see, or hear, or know; and you have not glorified the God in whose hand your breath is, and whose are all your ways. ²⁴Then the part of the hand was sent from before him, and this writing was inscribed. ²⁵"This is the writing that was inscribed: 'MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.' ²⁶"This is the interpretation of the thing: MENE: God has counted your kingdom, and brought it to an end. ²⁷TEKEL: you are weighed in the balances, and are found wanting. ²⁸PERES: your kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians." ²⁹Then Belshazzar commanded, and they clothed Daniel with purple, and put a chain of gold about his neck, and made proclamation concerning him, that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom. ³⁰In that night Belshazzar the Kasdian King was slain. ³¹Darius the Mede received the kingdom, being about sixty-two years old.

⁶It pleased Darius to set over the kingdom one hundred twenty local governors, who should be throughout the whole kingdom; ²and over them three presidents, of whom Daniel was one, that these local governors might give account to them, and that the king should suffer no loss. ³Then this Daniel was distinguished above the presidents and the local governors, because an excellent spirit was in him; and the king thought to set him over the whole realm. ⁴Then the presidents and the local governors sought to find occasion against Daniel as touching the kingdom; but they could find no occasion or fault, because he was faithful. There wasn't any error or fault found in him. ⁵Then these men said, "We won't find any occasion against this Daniel, unless we find it against him concerning the law of his God." ⁶Then these presidents and local governors assembled together to the king, and said this to him, "King Darius, live forever! ⁷All the presidents of the kingdom, the deputies and the local governors, the counselors and the governors, have consulted together to establish a royal statute and to make a strong decree, that whoever asks a petition of any god or man for thirty days, except of you, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions. ⁸Now, O king, establish the decree and sign the writing, that it not be changed, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which doesn't alter." ⁹Therefore King Darius signed the writing and the decree. ¹⁰When Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house (now his windows were open in his room toward Jerusalem) and he kneeled on his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did before. ¹¹Then these men assembled together, and found Daniel making petition and supplication before his God. ¹²Then they came near, and spoke before the king concerning the king's decree: "Haven't you signed a decree that every man who makes a petition to any god or man within thirty days, except to you, O king, shall be cast into the den of lions?" The king answered, "This thing is true, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which doesn't alter." ¹³Then they answered and said before the king, "That Daniel, who is of the children of the captivity of Judah, doesn't respect you, O king, nor the decree that you have signed, but makes his petition three times a day." ¹⁴Then the king, when he heard these words, was very displeased, and set his heart on Daniel to deliver him; and he labored until the going down of the sun to rescue him. ¹⁵Then these men assembled together to the king, and said to the king, "Know, O king, that it is a law of the Medes and Persians, that no decree nor statute which the king establishes may be changed." ¹⁶Then the king commanded, and they brought Daniel and cast him into the den of lions. The king spoke and said to Daniel, "Your God whom you serve continually, he will deliver you." ¹⁷A stone was brought, and laid on the mouth of the den; and the king sealed it with his own signet, and with the signet of his lords; that nothing might be changed concerning

Daniel. ¹⁸Then the king went to his palace, and passed the night fasting. No musical instruments were brought before him; and his sleep fled from him. ¹⁹Then the king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste to the den of lions. ²⁰When he came near to the den to Daniel, he cried with a troubled voice. The king spoke and said to Daniel, "Daniel, servant of the living God, is your God, whom you serve continually, able to deliver you from the lions?" ²¹Then Daniel said to the king, "O king, live forever! ²²My God has sent his angel, and has shut the lions' mouths, and they have not hurt me, because innocence was found in me before him; and also before you, O king, I have done no harm." ²³Then the king was exceedingly glad, and commanded that they should take Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no kind of harm was found on him, because he had trusted in his God. ²⁴The king commanded, and they brought those men who had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions—they, their children, and their wives; and the lions mauled them, and broke all their bones in pieces before they came to the bottom of the den. ²⁵Then King Darius wrote to all the peoples, nations, and languages who dwell in all the earth: "Peace be multiplied to you. ²⁶"I make a decree that in all the dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel. "For he is the living God, and steadfast forever. His kingdom is that which will not be destroyed. His dominion will be even to the end. ²⁷He delivers and rescues. He works signs and wonders in heaven and in earth, who has delivered Daniel from the power of the lions." ²⁸So this Daniel prospered in the reign of Darius and in the reign of Cyrus the Persian.

⁷In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon, Daniel had a dream and visions of his head while on his bed. Then he wrote the dream and told the sum of the matters. ²Daniel spoke and said, "I saw in my vision by night, and, behold, the four winds of the sky broke out on the great sea. ³Four great animals came up from the sea, different from one another. ⁴"The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings. I watched until its wings were plucked, and it was lifted up from the earth and made to stand on two feet as a man. A man's heart was given to it. ⁵"Behold, there was another animal, a second, like a bear. It was raised up on one side, and three ribs were in its mouth between its teeth. They said this to it: 'Arise! Devour much flesh!' ⁶"After this I saw, and behold, another, like a leopard, which had on its back four wings of a bird. The animal also had four heads; and dominion was given to it. ⁷"After this I saw in the night visions, and, behold, there was a fourth animal, awesome, powerful, and exceedingly strong. It had great iron teeth. It devoured and broke in pieces, and stamped the residue with its feet. It was different from all the animals that were before it. It had ten horns. ⁸"I considered the horns, and behold, there came

up among them another horn, a little one, before which three of the first horns were plucked up by the roots; and behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of a man, and a mouth speaking arrogantly. ⁹“I watched until thrones were placed, and one who was ancient of days sat. His clothing was white as snow, and the hair of his head like pure wool. His throne was fiery flames, and its wheels burning fire. ¹⁰A fiery stream issued and came out from before him. Thousands of thousands ministered to him. Ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him. The judgment was set. The books were opened. ¹¹“I watched at that time because of the voice of the arrogant words which the horn spoke. I watched even until the animal was slain, and its body destroyed, and it was given to be burned with fire. ¹²As for the rest of the animals, their dominion was taken away; yet their lives were prolonged for a season and a time. ¹³“I saw in the night visions, and behold, there came with the clouds of the sky one like a son of man, and he came even to the Ancient of Days, and they brought him near before him. ¹⁴Dominion was given him, and glory, and a kingdom, that all the peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion, which will not pass away, and his kingdom one that will not be destroyed. ¹⁵“As for me, Daniel, my spirit was grieved within my body, and the visions of my head troubled me. ¹⁶I came near to one of those who stood by, and asked him the truth concerning all this. “So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things. ¹⁷“These great animals, which are four, are four kings, who will arise out of the earth. ¹⁸But the holy ones of the Most High will receive the kingdom, and possess the kingdom forever, even forever and ever.” ¹⁹“Then I desired to know the truth concerning the fourth animal, which was different from all of them, exceedingly terrible, whose teeth were of iron, and its nails of bronze; which devoured, broke in pieces, and stamped the residue with its feet; ²⁰and concerning the ten horns that were on its head and the other horn which came up, and before which three fell, even that horn that had eyes and a mouth that spoke arrogantly, whose look was more stout than its fellows. ²¹I saw, and the same horn made war with the holy ones, and prevailed against them, ²²until the ancient of days came, and judgment was given to the holy ones of the Most High, and the time came that the holy ones possessed the kingdom. ²³“So he said, ‘The fourth animal will be a fourth kingdom on earth, which will be different from all the kingdoms, and will devour the whole earth, and will tread it down and break it in pieces. ²⁴As for the ten horns, ten kings will arise out of this kingdom. Another will arise after them; and he will be different from the former, and he will put down three kings. ²⁵He will speak words against the Most High, and will wear out the holy ones of the Most High. He will plan to change the times and the law; and they will be given into his hand

until a time and times and half a time. ²⁶“But the judgment will be set, and they will take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it to the end. ²⁷The kingdom and the dominion, and the greatness of the kingdoms under the whole sky, will be given to the people of the holy ones of the Most High. His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions will serve and obey him.’ ²⁸“Here is the end of the matter. As for me, Daniel, my thoughts troubled me greatly, and my face was changed in me; but I kept the matter in my heart.”

⁸In the third year of the reign of King Belshazzar, a vision appeared to me, even to me, Daniel, after that which appeared to me at the first. ²I saw the vision. Now it was so, that when I saw, I was in the citadel of Susa, which is in the province of Elam. I saw in the vision, and I was by the river Ulai. ³Then I lifted up my eyes and saw, and behold, a ram which had two horns stood before the river. The two horns were high, but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last. ⁴I saw the ram pushing westward, northward, and southward. No animals could stand before him. There wasn't any who could deliver out of his hand, but he did according to his will, and magnified himself. ⁵As I was considering, behold, a male goat came from the west over the surface of the whole earth, and didn't touch the ground. The goat had a notable horn between his eyes. ⁶He came to the ram that had the two horns, which I saw standing before the river, and ran on him in the fury of his power. ⁷I saw him come close to the ram, and he was moved with anger against him, and struck the ram, and broke his two horns. There was no power in the ram to stand before him; but he cast him down to the ground and trampled on him. There was no one who could deliver the ram out of his hand. ⁸The male goat magnified himself exceedingly. When he was strong, the great horn was broken; and instead of it there came up four notable horns toward the four winds of the sky. ⁹Out of one of them came out a little horn which grew exceedingly great—toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the glorious land. ¹⁰It grew great, even to the army of the sky; and it cast down some of the army and of the stars to the ground and trampled on them. ¹¹Yes, it magnified itself, even to the prince of the army; and it took away from him the continual burnt offering, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down. ¹²The army was given over to it together with the continual burnt offering through disobedience. It cast down truth to the ground, and it did its pleasure and prospered. ¹³Then I heard a holy one speaking; and another holy one said to that certain one who spoke, “How long will the vision about the continual burnt offering, and the disobedience that makes desolate, to give both the sanctuary and the army to be trodden under foot be?” ¹⁴He said to me, “To two thousand and three hundred evenings and mornings. Then the sanctuary

will be cleansed.” ¹⁵When I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, I sought to understand it. Then behold, there stood before me someone with the appearance of a man. ¹⁶I heard a man’s voice between the banks of the Ulai, which called and said, “Gabriel, make this man understand the vision.” ¹⁷So he came near where I stood; and when he came, I was frightened, and fell on my face; but he said to me, “Understand, son of man, for the vision belongs to the time of the end.” ¹⁸Now as he was speaking with me, I fell into a deep sleep with my face toward the ground; but he touched me and set me upright. ¹⁹He said, “Behold, I will make you know what will be in the latter time of the indignation, for it belongs to the appointed time of the end. ²⁰The ram which you saw, that had the two horns, they are the kings of Media and Persia. ²¹The rough male goat is the king of Greece. The great horn that is between his eyes is the first king. ²²As for that which was broken, in the place where four stood up, four kingdoms will stand up out of the nation, but not with his power. ²³“In the latter time of their kingdom, when the transgressors have come to the full, a king of fierce face, and understanding riddles, will stand up. ²⁴His power will be mighty, but not by his own power. He will destroy awesomely, and will prosper in what he does. He will destroy the mighty ones and the holy people. ²⁵Through his policy he will cause deceit to prosper in his hand. He will magnify himself in his heart, and he will destroy many in their security. He will also stand up against the prince of princes, but he will be broken without human hands. ²⁶“The vision of the evenings and mornings which has been told is true; but seal up the vision, for it belongs to many days to come.” ²⁷I, Daniel, fainted, and was sick for some days. Then I rose up and did the king’s business. I wondered at the vision, but no one understood it.

⁹In the first year of Darius the son of Ahasuerus, of the offspring of the Medes, who was made king over the realm of the Kasdim— ²in the first year of his reign I, Daniel, understood by the books the number of the years about which the LORD’s ^{vi} word came to Jeremiah the prophet for the accomplishing of the desolations of Jerusalem, even seventy years. ³I set my face to the Lord God, to seek by prayer and petitions, with fasting and sackcloth and ashes. ⁴I prayed to the LORD my God, and made confession, and said, “Oh, Lord, the great and dreadful God, who keeps covenant and loving kindness with those who love him and keep his commandments, ⁵we have sinned, and have dealt perversely, and have done wickedly, and have rebelled, even turning aside from your precepts and from your ordinances. ⁶We haven’t listened to your servants the prophets, who spoke in your name to our kings, our princes, and our fathers, and to all the people of the land. ⁷“Lord,

righteousness belongs to you, but to us confusion of face, as it is today; to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to all Israel, who are near and who are far off, through all the countries where you have driven them, because of their trespass that they have trespassed against you. ⁸Lord, to us belongs confusion of face, to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers, because we have sinned against you. ⁹To the Lord our God belong mercies and forgiveness, for we have rebelled against him. ¹⁰We haven’t obeyed the LORD our God’s voice, to walk in his laws, which he set before us by his servants the prophets. ¹¹Yes, all Israel have transgressed your law, turning aside, that they should not obey your voice. “Therefore the curse and the oath written in the Torah of Moses the servant of God has been poured out on us, for we have sinned against him. ¹²He has confirmed his words, which he spoke against us and against our judges who judged us, by bringing on us a great evil; for under the whole sky, such has not been done as has been done to Jerusalem. ¹³As it is written in the Torah of Moses, all this evil has come on us. Yet we have not entreated the favor of the LORD our God, that we should turn from our iniquities and have discernment in your truth. ¹⁴Therefore the LORD has watched over the evil, and brought it on us; for the LORD our God is righteous in all his works which he does, and we have not obeyed his voice. ¹⁵“Now, Lord our God, who has brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, and have gotten yourself renown, as it is today, we have sinned. We have done wickedly. ¹⁶Lord, according to all your righteousness, please let your anger and your wrath be turned away from your city Jerusalem, your holy mountain; because for our sins and for the iniquities of our fathers, Jerusalem and your people have become a reproach to all who are around us. ¹⁷“Now therefore, our God, listen to the prayer of your servant and to his petitions, and cause your face to shine on your sanctuary that is desolate, for the Lord’s sake. ¹⁸My God, turn your ear and hear. Open your eyes and see our desolations, and the city which is called by your name; for we do not present our petitions before you for our righteousness, but for your great mercies’ sake. ¹⁹Lord, hear. Lord, forgive. Lord, listen and do. Don’t defer, for your own sake, my God, because your city and your people are called by your name.” ²⁰While I was speaking, praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before the LORD my God for the holy mountain of my God— ²¹yes, while I was speaking in prayer—the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening offering. ²²He instructed me and talked with me, and said, “Daniel, I have now come to give you wisdom and understanding. ²³At the beginning of your petitions the commandment went out, and I have come to tell you, for you are greatly beloved. Therefore consider the matter

^{vi}When rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

and understand the vision. ²⁴“Seventy weeks are decreed on your people and on your holy city, to finish disobedience, to make an end of sins, to make reconciliation for iniquity, to bring in everlasting righteousness, to seal up vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most holy. ²⁵“Know therefore and discern that from the going out of the commandment to restore and build Jerusalem to the Anointed One, ^{vii} the prince, will be seven weeks and sixty-two weeks. It will be built again, with street and moat, even in troubled times. ²⁶After the sixty-two weeks the Anointed One ^{viii} will be cut off, and will have nothing. The people of the prince who come will destroy the city and the sanctuary. Its end will be with a flood, and war will be even to the end. Desolations are determined. ²⁷He will make a firm covenant with many for one week. In the middle of the week he will cause the sacrifice and the offering to cease. On the wing of abominations will come one who makes desolate; and even to the decreed full end, wrath will be poured out on the desolate.”

10In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia a message was revealed to Daniel, whose name was called Belteshazzar; and the message was true, even a great warfare. He understood the message, and had understanding of the vision. ²In those days I, Daniel, was mourning three whole weeks. ³I ate no pleasant food. No meat or wine came into my mouth. I didn’t anoint myself at all, until three whole weeks were fulfilled. ⁴In the twenty-fourth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel, ^{ix} ⁵I lifted up my eyes and looked, and behold, there was a man clothed in linen, whose waist was adorned with pure gold of Uphaz. ⁶His body also was like beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as flaming torches. His arms and his feet were like burnished bronze. The voice of his words was like the voice of a multitude. ⁷I, Daniel, alone saw the vision, for the men who were with me didn’t see the vision, but a great quaking fell on them, and they fled to hide themselves. ⁸So I was left alone and saw this great vision. No strength remained in me; for my face grew deathly pale, and I retained no strength. ⁹Yet I heard the voice of his words. When I heard the voice of his words, then I fell into a deep sleep on my face, with my face toward the ground. ¹⁰Behold, a hand touched me, which set me on my knees and on the palms of my hands. ¹¹He said to me, “Daniel, you greatly beloved man, understand the words that I speak to you, and stand upright, for I have been sent to you, now.” When he had spoken this word to me, I stood trembling. ¹²Then he said to me, “Don’t be afraid, Daniel; for from the first day that you set

your heart to understand, and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard. I have come for your words’ sake. ¹³But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days; but, behold, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me because I remained there with the kings of Persia. ¹⁴Now I have come to make you understand what will happen to your people in the latter days, for the vision is yet for many days.” ¹⁵When he had spoken these words to me, I set my face toward the ground and was mute. ¹⁶Behold, one in the likeness of the sons of men touched my lips. Then I opened my mouth, and spoke and said to him who stood before me, “My lord, by reason of the vision my sorrows have overtaken me, and I retain no strength. ¹⁷For how can the servant of this my lord talk with this my lord? For as for me, immediately there remained no strength in me. There was no breath left in me.” ¹⁸Then one like the appearance of a man touched me again, and he strengthened me. ¹⁹He said, “Greatly beloved man, don’t be afraid. Peace be to you. Be strong. Yes, be strong.” When he spoke to me, I was strengthened, and said, “Let my lord speak, for you have strengthened me.” ²⁰Then he said, “Do you know why I have come to you? Now I will return to fight with the prince of Persia. When I go out, behold, the prince of Greece will come. ²¹But I will tell you that which is inscribed in the writing of truth. There is no one who holds with me against these but Michael your prince.

11“As for me, in the first year of Darius the Mede, I stood up to confirm and strengthen him. ²“Now I will show you the truth. Behold, three more kings will stand up in Persia. The fourth will be far richer than all of them. When he has grown strong through his riches, he will stir up all against the realm of Greece. ³A mighty king will stand up, who will rule with great dominion, and do according to his will. ⁴When he stands up, his kingdom will be broken and will be divided toward the four winds of the sky, but not to his posterity, nor according to his dominion with which he ruled; for his kingdom will be plucked up, even for others besides these. ⁵“The king of the south will be strong. One of his princes will become stronger than him, and have dominion. His dominion will be a great dominion. ⁶At the end of years they will join themselves together; and the daughter of the king of the south will come to the king of the north to make an agreement, but she will not retain the strength of her arm. He will also not stand, nor will his arm; but she will be given up, with those who brought her, and he who became the father of her, and he who strengthened her in those times. ⁷“But out of a shoot from her roots one will stand up in his place, who will come to the army and will enter into the fortress of the king of the north, and will deal against them and will prevail. ⁸He will also carry their gods with their molten images, and with their goodly vessels of sil-

^{vii}“Anointed One” can also be translated “Messiah” (same as “Messiah”).

^{viii}“Anointed One” can also be translated “Messiah” (same as “Messiah”).

^{ix}or, Tigris River

ver and of gold, captive into Egypt. He will refrain some years from the king of the north. ⁹He will come into the realm of the king of the south, but he will return into his own land. ¹⁰His sons will wage war, and will assemble a multitude of great forces which will come on, and overflow, and pass through. They will return and wage war, even to his fortress. ¹¹¹⁴The king of the south will be moved with anger and will come out and fight with him, even with the king of the north. He will send out a great multitude, and the multitude will be given into his hand. ¹²The multitude will be carried off, and his heart will be exalted. He will cast down tens of thousands, but he won't prevail. ¹³The king of the north will return, and will send out a multitude greater than the former. He will come on at the end of the times, even of years, with a great army and with abundant supplies. ¹⁴^{In those times many will stand up against the king of the south. Also the children of the violent among your people will lift themselves up to establish the vision, but they will fall. ¹⁵So the king of the north will come and cast up a mound, and take a well-fortified city. The forces of the south won't stand, neither will his select troops, neither will there be any strength to stand. ¹⁶But he who comes against him will do according to his own will, and no one will stand before him. He will stand in the glorious land, and destruction will be in his hand. ¹⁷He will set his face to come with the strength of his whole kingdom, and with him equitable conditions. He will perform them. He will give him the daughter of women, to destroy the kingdom, but she will not stand, and won't be for him. ¹⁸After this he will turn his face to the islands, and will take many, but a prince will cause the reproach offered by him to cease. Yes, moreover, he will cause his reproach to turn on him. ¹⁹Then he will turn his face toward the fortresses of his own land; but he will stumble and fall, and won't be found. ²⁰^{Then one who will cause a tax collector to pass through the kingdom to maintain its glory will stand up in his place; but within few days he shall be destroyed, not in anger, and not in battle. ²¹In his place a contemptible person will stand up, to whom they had not given the honor of the kingdom; but he will come in time of security, and will obtain the kingdom by flatteries. ²²The overwhelming forces will be overwhelmed from before him, and will be broken. Yes, also the prince of the covenant. ²³After the treaty made with him he will work deceitfully; for he will come up and will become strong with few people. ²⁴In time of security he will come even on the fattest places of the province. He will do that which his fathers have not done, nor his fathers' fathers. He will scatter among them prey, plunder, and wealth. Yes, he will devise his plans against the strongholds, but only for a time. ²⁵He will stir up his power and his courage against the king of the south with a great army; and the king of the south will wage war in battle with an exceedingly great and mighty army, but he}}

won't stand; for they will devise plans against him. ²⁶Yes, those who eat of his delicacies will destroy him, and his army will be swept away. Many will fall down slain. ²⁷As for both these kings, their hearts will be to do evil, and they will speak lies at one table; but it won't prosper, for the end will still be at the appointed time. ²⁸Then he will return into his land with great wealth. His heart will be against the holy covenant. He will take action, and return to his own land. ²⁹^{He will return at the appointed time and come into the south; but it won't be in the latter time as it was in the former. ³⁰For ships of Kittim will come against him. Therefore he will be grieved, and will return, and have indignation against the holy covenant, and will take action. He will even return, and have regard to those who forsake the holy covenant. ³¹Forces from him will profane the sanctuary, even the fortress, and will take away the continual burnt offering. Then they will set up the abomination that makes desolate. ³²He will corrupt those who do wickedly against the covenant by flatteries; but the people who know their God will be strong and take action. ³³Those who are wise among the people will instruct many; yet they will fall by the sword and by flame, by captivity and by plunder, many days. ³⁴Now when they fall, they will be helped with a little help; but many will join themselves to them with flatteries. ³⁵Some of those who are wise will fall—to refine them, and to purify, and to make them white, even to the time of the end, because it is yet for the time appointed. ³⁶The king will do according to his will. He will exalt himself and magnify himself above every god, and will speak marvelous things against the God of gods. He will prosper until the indignation is accomplished, for that which is determined will be done. ³⁷He won't regard the gods of his fathers, or the desire of women, or regard any god; for he will magnify himself above all. ³⁸But in their place, he will honor the god of fortresses. He will honor a god whom his fathers didn't know with gold, silver, and with precious stones and pleasant things. ³⁹He will deal with the strongest fortresses by the help of a foreign god. He will increase with glory whoever acknowledges him. He will cause them to rule over many, and will divide the land for a price. ⁴⁰At the time of the end the king of the south will contend with him; and the king of the north will come against him like a whirlwind, with chariots, with horsemen, and with many ships. He will enter into the countries, and will overflow and pass through. ⁴¹He will enter also into the glorious land, and many countries will be overthrown; but these will be delivered out of his hand: Edom, Moab, and the chief of the children of Ammon. ⁴²He will also stretch out his hand on the countries. The land of Egypt won't escape. ⁴³But he will have power over the treasures of gold and of silver, and over all the precious things of Egypt. The Libyans and the Ethiopians will follow his steps. ⁴⁴But news out of the east and out of the north will trouble him; and he will go}

out with great fury to destroy and utterly to sweep away many. ⁴⁵He will plant the tents of his palace between the sea and the glorious holy mountain; yet he will come to his end, and no one will help him.

12“At that time Michael will stand up, the great prince who stands for the children of your people; and there will be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time. At that time your people will be delivered, everyone who is found written in the book. ²Many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt. ³Those who are wise will shine as the brightness of the expanse. Those who turn many to righteousness will shine as the stars forever and ever. ⁴But you, Daniel, shut up the words and seal the book, even to the time of the end. Many will run back and forth, and knowledge will be increased.” ⁵Then I, Daniel, looked, and behold, two others stood, one on the river bank on this side, and the other on the river bank on that side. ⁶One said to the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, “How long will it be to the end of these wonders?” ⁷I heard the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand to heaven, and swore by him who lives forever that it will be for a time, times, and a half; and when they have finished breaking in pieces the power of the holy people, all these things will be finished. ⁸I heard, but I didn’t understand. Then I said, “My lord, what will be the outcome of these things?” ⁹He said, “Go your way, Daniel; for the words are shut up and sealed until the time of the end. ¹⁰Many will purify themselves, and make themselves white, and be refined, but the wicked will do wickedly; and none of the wicked will understand, but those who are wise will understand. ¹¹“From the time that the continual burnt offering is taken away and the abomination that makes desolate set up, there will be one thousand two hundred ninety days. ¹²Blessed is he who waits, and comes to the one thousand three hundred thirty-five days. ¹³“But go your way until the end; for you will rest, and will stand in your inheritance at the end of the days.”

Hosea

¹The LORD's ⁱ word that came to Hosea the son of Beeri, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel. ²When the LORD spoke at first by Hosea, the LORD said to Hosea, "Go, take for yourself a wife of prostitution and children of unfaithfulness; for the land commits great adultery, forsaking the LORD." ³So he went and took Gomer the daughter of Diblaim; and she conceived, and bore him a son. ⁴The LORD said to him, "Call his name Jezreel, for yet a little while, and I will avenge the blood of Jezreel on the house of Jehu, and will cause the kingdom of the house of Israel to cease. ⁵It will happen in that day that I will break the bow of Israel in the valley of Jezreel." ⁶She conceived again, and bore a daughter. Then he said to him, "Call her name Lo-Ruhamah, ⁱⁱ for I will no longer have mercy on the house of Israel, that I should in any way pardon them. ⁷But I will have mercy on the house of Judah, and will save them by the LORD their God, ⁱⁱⁱ and will not save them by bow, sword, battle, horses, or horsemen." ⁸Now when she had weaned Lo-Ruhamah, she conceived, and bore a son. ⁹He said, "Call his name Lo-Ammi, ^{iv} for you are not my people, and I will not be yours. ¹⁰Yet the number of the children of Israel will be as the sand of the sea, which can't be measured or counted; and it will come to pass that, in the place where it was said to them, 'You are not my people,' they will be called 'sons of the living God.' ¹¹The children of Judah and the children of Israel will be gathered together, and they will appoint themselves one head, and will go up from the land; for great will be the day of Jezreel.

²"Say to your brothers, 'My people!' ^v and to your sisters, 'My loved one!' ^{vi} ²Contend with your mother! Contend, for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband; and let her put away her prostitution from her face, and her adulteries from between her breasts; ³lest I strip her

naked, and make her bare as in the day that she was born, and make her like a wilderness, and set her like a dry land, and kill her with thirst. ⁴Indeed, on her children I will have no mercy, for they are children of unfaithfulness. ⁵For their mother has played the prostitute. She who conceived them has done shamefully; for she said, 'I will go after my lovers, who give me my bread and my water, my wool and my flax, my oil and my drink.' ⁶Therefore behold, ^{vii} I will hedge up your way with thorns, and I will build a wall against her, that she can't find her way. ⁷She will follow after her lovers, but she won't overtake them; and she will seek them, but won't find them. Then she will say, 'I will go and return to my first husband, for then it was better with me than now.' ⁸For she didn't know that I gave her the grain, the new wine, and the oil, and multiplied to her silver and gold, which they used for Baal. ⁹Therefore I will take back my grain in its time, and my new wine in its season, and will pluck away my wool and my flax which should have covered her nakedness. ¹⁰Now I will uncover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and no one will deliver her out of my hand. ¹¹I will also cause all her celebrations to cease: her feasts, her new moons, her Sabbaths, and all her solemn assemblies. ¹²I will lay waste her vines and her fig trees, about which she has said, 'These are my wages that my lovers have given me,' and I will make them a forest, and the animals of the field shall eat them. ¹³I will visit on her the days of the Baals, to which she burned incense when she decked herself with her earrings and her jewels, and went after her lovers and forgot me," says the LORD. ¹⁴"Therefore behold, I will allure her, and bring her into the wilderness, and speak tenderly to her. ¹⁵I will give her vineyards from there, and the valley of Achor for a door of hope; and she will respond there as in the days of her youth, and as in the day when she came up out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁶It will be in that day," says the LORD, "that you will call me 'my husband,' and no longer call me 'my master.' ¹⁷For I will take away the names of the Baals out of her mouth, and they will no longer be mentioned by name. ¹⁸In that day I will make a covenant for them with the animals of the field, and with the birds of the sky,

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱLo-Ruhamah means "not loved".

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim".

^{iv}Lo-Ammi means "not my people".

^v'Ammi' in Hebrew

^{vi}'Ruhamah' in Hebrew

^{vii}"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

and with the creeping things of the ground. I will break the bow, the sword, and the battle out of the land, and will make them lie down safely. ¹⁹I will betroth you to me forever. Yes, I will betroth you to me in righteousness, in justice, in loving kindness, and in compassion. ²⁰I will even betroth you to me in faithfulness; and you shall know the LORD. ²¹It will happen in that day, that I will respond," says the LORD. "I will respond to the heavens, and they will respond to the earth; ²²and the earth will respond to the grain, and the new wine, and the oil; and they will respond to Jezreel. ²³I will sow her to me in the earth; and I will have mercy on her who had not obtained mercy; and I will tell those who were not my people, 'You are my people;' and they will say, 'You are My God!'"

3The LORD said to me, "Go again, love a woman loved by another, and an adulteress, even as the LORD loves the children of Israel, though they turn to other gods, and love cakes of raisins." ²So I bought her for myself for fifteen pieces of silver and a homer^{viii} and a half of barley. ³I said to her, "You shall stay with me many days. You shall not play the prostitute, and you shall not be with any other man. I will also be so toward you." ⁴For the children of Israel shall live many days without king, without prince, without sacrifice, without sacred stone, and without ephod or idols. ⁵Afterward the children of Israel shall return and seek the LORD their God, and David their king, and shall come with trembling to the LORD and to his blessings in the last days.

4Hear the LORD's word, you children of Israel, for the LORD has a charge against the inhabitants of the land: "Indeed there is no truth, nor goodness, nor knowledge of God in the land. ²There is cursing, lying, murder, stealing, and committing adultery; they break boundaries, and bloodshed causes bloodshed. ³Therefore the land will mourn, and everyone who dwells in it will waste away, with all living things in her, even the animals of the field and the birds of the sky; yes, the fish of the sea also die. ⁴"Yet let no man bring a charge, neither let any man accuse; for your people are like those who bring charges against a priest. ⁵You will stumble in the day, and the prophet will also stumble with you in the night; and I will destroy your mother. ⁶My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge. Because you have rejected knowledge, I will also reject you, that you may be no priest to me. Because you have forgotten your God's Torah, I will also forget your children. ⁷As they were multiplied, so they sinned against me. I will change their glory into shame. ⁸They feed on the sin of my people, and set their heart on their iniquity. ⁹It will be like people, like priest; and I will punish them for their ways, and will repay them for their deeds. ¹⁰They

will eat, and not have enough. They will play the prostitute, and will not increase; because they have abandoned listening to the LORD. ¹¹Prostitution, wine, and new wine take away understanding. ¹²My people consult with their wooden idol, and answer to a stick of wood. Indeed the spirit of prostitution has led them astray, and they have been unfaithful to their God. ¹³They sacrifice on the tops of the mountains, and burn incense on the hills, under oaks, poplars, and terebinths, because its shade is good. Therefore your daughters play the prostitute, and your brides commit adultery. ¹⁴I will not punish your daughters when they play the prostitute, nor your brides when they commit adultery; because the men consort with prostitutes, and they sacrifice with the shrine prostitutes; so the people without understanding will come to ruin. ¹⁵"Though you, Israel, play the prostitute, yet don't let Judah offend; and don't come to Gilgal, neither go up to Beth Aven, nor swear, 'As the LORD lives.' ¹⁶For Israel has behaved extremely stubbornly, like a stubborn heifer. Then how will the LORD feed them like a lamb in a meadow? ¹⁷Ephraim is joined to idols. Leave him alone! ¹⁸Their drink has become sour. They play the prostitute continually. Her rulers dearly love their shameful way. ¹⁹The wind has wrapped her up in its wings; and they shall be disappointed because of their sacrifices.

5"Listen to this, you priests! Listen, house of Israel, and give ear, house of the king! For the judgment is against you; for you have been a snare at Mizpah, and a net spread on Tabor. ²The rebels are deep in slaughter, but I discipline all of them. ³I know Ephraim, and Israel is not hidden from me; for now, Ephraim, you have played the prostitute. Israel is defiled. ⁴Their deeds won't allow them to turn to their God, for the spirit of prostitution is within them, and they don't know the LORD. ⁵The pride of Israel testifies to his face. Therefore Israel and Ephraim will stumble in their iniquity. Judah also will stumble with them. ⁶They will go with their flocks and with their herds to seek the LORD, but they won't find him. He has withdrawn himself from them. ⁷They are unfaithful to the LORD; for they have borne illegitimate children. Now the new moon will devour them with their fields. ⁸"Blow the cornet in Gibeah, and the shofar in Ramah! Sound a battle cry at Beth Aven, behind you, Benjamin! ⁹Ephraim will become a desolation in the day of rebuke. Among the tribes of Israel, I have made known that which will surely be. ¹⁰The princes of Judah are like those who remove a landmark. I will pour out my wrath on them like water. ¹¹Ephraim is oppressed, he is crushed in judgment, because he is intent in his pursuit of idols. ¹²Therefore I am to Ephraim like a moth, and to the house of Judah like rottenness. ¹³"When Ephraim saw his sickness, and Judah his wound, then Ephraim went to Assyria, and sent to King Jareb: but he is not able to heal you, neither will he cure you of

^{viii}1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

your wound. ¹⁴For I will be to Ephraim like a lion, and like a young lion to the house of Judah. I myself will tear in pieces and go away. I will carry off, and there will be no one to deliver. ¹⁵I will go and return to my place, until they acknowledge their offense, and seek my face. In their affliction they will seek me earnestly.”

6“Come! Let’s return to the LORD; for he has torn us to pieces, and he will heal us; he has injured us, and he will bind up our wounds. ²After two days he will revive us. On the third day he will raise us up, and we will live before him. ³Let’s acknowledge the LORD. Let’s press on to know the LORD. As surely as the sun rises, The LORD will appear. He will come to us like the rain, like the spring rain that waters the earth.” ⁴“Ephraim, what shall I do to you? Judah, what shall I do to you? For your love is like a morning cloud, and like the dew that disappears early. ⁵Therefore I have cut them to pieces with the prophets; I killed them with the words of my mouth. Your judgments are like a flash of lightning. ⁶For I desire mercy, and not sacrifice; and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings. ⁷But they, like Adam, have broken the covenant. They were unfaithful to me there. ⁸Gilead is a city of those who work iniquity; it is stained with blood. ⁹As gangs of robbers wait to ambush a man, so the company of priests murder on the path toward Shechem, committing shameful crimes. ¹⁰In the house of Israel I have seen a horrible thing. There is prostitution in Ephraim. Israel is defiled. ¹¹“Also, Judah, there is a harvest appointed for you, when I restore the fortunes of my people.

7When I would heal Israel, then the iniquity of Ephraim is uncovered, also the wickedness of Samaria; for they commit falsehood, and the thief enters in, and the gang of robbers ravages outside. ²They don’t consider in their hearts that I remember all their wickedness. Now their own deeds have engulfed them. They are before my face. ³They make the king glad with their wickedness, and the princes with their lies. ⁴They are all adulterers. They are burning like an oven that the baker stops stirring, from the kneading of the dough, until it is leavened. ⁵On the day of our king, the princes made themselves sick with the heat of wine. He joined his hand with mockers. ⁶For they have prepared their heart like an oven, while they lie in wait. Their anger smolders all night. In the morning it burns as a flaming fire. ⁷They are all hot as an oven, and devour their judges. All their kings have fallen. There is no one among them who calls to me. ⁸Ephraim mixes himself among the nations. Ephraim is a pancake not turned over. ⁹Strangers have devoured his strength, and he doesn’t realize it. Indeed, gray hairs are here and there on him, and he doesn’t realize it. ¹⁰The pride of Israel testifies to his face; yet they haven’t returned to the LORD their God,

nor sought him, for all this. ¹¹“Ephraim is like an easily deceived dove, without understanding. They call to Egypt. They go to Assyria. ¹²When they go, I will spread my net on them. I will bring them down like the birds of the sky. I will chastise them, as their congregation has heard. ¹³Woe to them! For they have wandered from me. Destruction to them! For they have trespassed against me. Though I would redeem them, yet they have spoken lies against me. ¹⁴They haven’t cried to me with their heart, but they howl on their beds. They assemble themselves for grain and new wine. They turn away from me. ¹⁵Though I have taught and strengthened their arms, yet they plot evil against me. ¹⁶They return, but not to the Most High. They are like a faulty bow. Their princes will fall by the sword for the rage of their tongue. This will be their derision in the land of Egypt.

8“Put the shofar to your lips! Something like an eagle is over the LORD’s house, because they have broken my covenant and rebelled against my law. ²They cry to me, ‘My God, we, Israel, acknowledge you!’ ³Israel has cast off that which is good. The enemy will pursue him. ⁴They have set up kings, but not by me. They have made princes, and I didn’t approve. Of their silver and their gold they have made themselves idols, that they may be cut off. ⁵Let Samaria throw out his calf idol! My anger burns against them! How long will it be until they are capable of purity? ⁶For this is even from Israel! The workman made it, and it is no God; indeed, the calf of Samaria shall be broken in pieces. ⁷For they sow the wind, and they will reap the whirlwind. He has no standing grain. The stalk will yield no head. If it does yield, strangers will swallow it up. ⁸Israel is swallowed up. Now they are among the nations like a worthless thing. ⁹For they have gone up to Assyria, like a wild donkey wandering alone. Ephraim has hired lovers for himself. ¹⁰But although they sold themselves among the nations, I will now gather them; and they begin to waste away because of the oppression of the king of mighty ones. ¹¹Because Ephraim has multiplied altars for sinning, they became for him altars for sinning. ¹²I wrote for him the many things of my law, but they were regarded as a strange thing. ¹³As for the sacrifices of my offerings, they sacrifice meat and eat it, but the LORD doesn’t accept them. Now he will remember their iniquity, and punish their sins. They will return to Egypt. ¹⁴For Israel has forgotten his Maker and built palaces; and Judah has multiplied fortified cities; but I will send a fire on his cities, and it will devour its fortresses.”

9Don’t rejoice, Israel, to jubilation like the nations; for you were unfaithful to your God. You love the wages of a prostitute at every grain threshing floor. ²The threshing floor and the wine press won’t feed them, and the new wine will fail her. ³They won’t dwell in the LORD’s land; but

Ephraim will return to Egypt, and they will eat unclean food in Assyria. ⁴They won't pour out wine offerings to the LORD, neither will they be pleasing to him. Their sacrifices will be to them like the bread of mourners; all who eat of it will be polluted; for their bread will be for their appetite. It will not come into the LORD's house. ⁵What will you do in the day of solemn assembly, and in the day of the feast of the LORD? ⁶For, behold, when they flee destruction, Egypt will gather them up. Memphis will bury them. Nettles will possess their pleasant things of silver. Thorns will be in their tents. ⁷The days of visitation have come. The days of reckoning have come. Israel will consider the prophet to be a fool, and the man who is inspired to be insane, because of the abundance of your sins, and because your hostility is great. ⁸A prophet watches over Ephraim with my God. A fowler's snare is on all of his paths, and hostility in the house of his God. ⁹They have deeply corrupted themselves, as in the days of Gibeah. He will remember their iniquity. He will punish them for their sins. ¹⁰I found Israel like grapes in the wilderness. I saw your fathers as the first ripe in the fig tree at its first season; but they came to Baal Peor, and consecrated themselves to the shameful thing, and became abominable like that which they loved. ¹¹As for Ephraim, their glory will fly away like a bird. There will be no birth, no one with child, and no conception. ¹²Though they bring up their children, yet I will bereave them, so that not a man shall be left. Indeed, woe also to them when I depart from them! ¹³I have seen Ephraim, like Tyre, planted in a pleasant place; but Ephraim will bring out his children to the murderer. ¹⁴Give them—LORD what will you give? Give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts. ¹⁵"All their wickedness is in Gilgal; for there I hated them. Because of the wickedness of their deeds, I will drive them out of my house! I will love them no more. All their princes are rebels. ¹⁶Ephraim is struck. Their root has dried up. They will bear no fruit. Even though they give birth, yet I will kill the beloved ones of their womb." ¹⁷My God will cast them away, because they didn't listen to him; and they will be wanderers among the nations.

10 Israel is a luxuriant vine that produces his fruit. According to the abundance of his fruit he has multiplied his altars. As their land has prospered, they have adorned their sacred stones. ²Their heart is divided. Now they will be found guilty. He will demolish their altars. He will destroy their sacred stones. ³Surely now they will say, "We have no king; for we don't fear the LORD; and the king, what can he do for us?" ⁴They make promises, swearing falsely in making covenants. Therefore judgment springs up like poisonous weeds in the furrows of the field. ⁵The inhabitants of Samaria will be in terror for the calves of Beth Aven, for its people will mourn over it, along with its priests who rejoiced over it, for its glory, because it has

departed from it. ⁶It also will be carried to Assyria for a present to a great king. Ephraim will receive shame, and Israel will be ashamed of his own counsel. ⁷Samaria and her king float away like a twig on the water. ⁸The high places also of Aven, the sin of Israel, will be destroyed. The thorn and the thistle will come up on their altars. They will tell the mountains, "Cover us!" and the hills, "Fall on us!" ⁹"Israel, you have sinned from the days of Gibeah. There they remained. The battle against the children of iniquity doesn't overtake them in Gibeah. ¹⁰When it is my desire, I will chastise them; and the nations will be gathered against them when they are bound to their two transgressions. ¹¹Ephraim is a trained heifer that loves to thresh, so I will put a yoke on her beautiful neck. I will set a rider on Ephraim. Judah will plow. Jacob will break his clods. ¹²Sow to yourselves in righteousness, reap according to kindness. Break up your fallow ground, for it is time to seek the LORD, until he comes and rains righteousness on you. ¹³You have plowed wickedness. You have reaped iniquity. You have eaten the fruit of lies, for you trusted in your way, in the multitude of your mighty men. ¹⁴Therefore a battle roar will arise among your people, and all your fortresses will be destroyed, as Shalman destroyed Beth Arbel in the day of battle. The mother was dashed in pieces with her children. ¹⁵So Bethel will do to you because of your great wickedness. At daybreak the king of Israel will be destroyed.

11 "When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt. ²They called to them, so they went from them. They sacrificed to the Baals, and burned incense to engraved images. ³Yet I taught Ephraim to walk. I took them by their arms, but they didn't know that I healed them. ⁴I drew them with cords of a man, with ties of love; and I was to them like those who lift up the yoke on their necks; and I bent down to him and I fed him. ⁵"They won't return into the land of Egypt; but the Assyrian will be their king, because they refused to repent. ⁶The sword will fall on their cities, and will destroy the bars of their gates, and will put an end to their plans. ⁷My people are determined to turn from me. Though they call to the Most High, he certainly won't exalt them. ⁸"How can I give you up, Ephraim? How can I hand you over, Israel? How can I make you like Admah? How can I make you like Zeboiim? My heart is turned within me, my compassion is aroused. ⁹I will not execute the fierceness of my anger. I will not return to destroy Ephraim, for I am God, and not man—the Holy One among you. I will not come in wrath. ¹⁰They will walk after the LORD, who will roar like a lion; for he will roar, and the children will come trembling from the west. ¹¹They will come trembling like a bird out of Egypt, and like a dove out of the land of Assyria; and I will settle them in their houses," says the LORD. ¹²Ephraim surrounds me with falsehood, and the

house of Israel with deceit. Judah still strays from God, and is unfaithful to the Holy One.

12Ephraim feeds on wind, and chases the east wind. He continually multiplies lies and desolation. They make a covenant with Assyria, and oil is carried into Egypt. ²The LORD also has a controversy with Judah, and will punish Jacob according to his ways; according to his deeds he will repay him. ³In the womb he took his brother by the heel, and in his manhood he contended with God. ⁴Indeed, he struggled with the angel, and prevailed; he wept, and made supplication to him. He found him at Bethel, and there he spoke with us— ⁵even the LORD, the God of Hosts. The LORD is his name of renown! ⁶Therefore turn to your God. Keep kindness and justice, and wait continually for your God. ⁷A merchant has dishonest scales in his hand. He loves to defraud. ⁸Ephraim said, “Surely I have become rich. I have found myself wealth. In all my wealth they won’t find in me any iniquity that is sin.” ⁹“But I am the LORD your God from the land of Egypt. I will yet again make you dwell in tents, as in the days of the solemn feast. ¹⁰I have also spoken to the prophets, and I have multiplied visions; and by the ministry of the prophets I have used parables. ¹¹If Gilead is wicked, surely they are worthless. In Gilgal they sacrifice bulls. Indeed, their altars are like heaps in the furrows of the field. ¹²Jacob fled into the country of Aram. Israel served to get a wife. For a wife he tended flocks and herds. ¹³By a prophet the LORD brought Israel up out of Egypt, and by a prophet he was preserved. ¹⁴Ephraim has bitterly provoked anger. Therefore his blood will be left on him, and his Lord ^{ix} will repay his contempt.

13When Ephraim spoke, there was trembling. He exalted himself in Israel, but when he became guilty through Baal, he died. ²Now they sin more and more, and have made themselves molten images of their silver, even idols according to their own understanding, all of them the work of the craftsmen. They say of them, ‘They offer human sacrifice and kiss the calves.’ ³Therefore they will be like the morning mist, like the dew that passes away early, like the chaff that is driven with the whirlwind out of the threshing floor, and like the smoke out of the chimney. ⁴“Yet I am the LORD your God from the land of Egypt; and you shall acknowledge no god but me, and besides me there is no savior. ⁵I knew you in the wilderness, in the land of great drought. ⁶According to their pasture, so were they filled; they were filled, and their heart was exalted. Therefore they have forgotten me. ⁷Therefore I am like a lion to them. Like a leopard, I will lurk by the path. ⁸I will meet them like a bear that is bereaved of her cubs, and will tear the covering of their heart. There I will devour them like a lioness. The wild animal will tear them. ⁹You

are destroyed, Israel, because you are against me, against your helper. ¹⁰Where is your king now, that he may save you in all your cities? And your judges, of whom you said, ‘Give me a king and princes’? ¹¹I have given you a king in my anger, and have taken him away in my wrath. ¹²The guilt of Ephraim is stored up. His sin is stored up. ¹³The sorrows of a travailing woman will come on him. He is an unwise son, for when it is time, he doesn’t come to the opening of the womb. ¹⁴I will ransom them from the power of Sheol. ^x I will redeem them from death! Death, where are your plagues? Sheol, where is your destruction? “Compassion will be hidden from my eyes. ¹⁵Though he is fruitful among his brothers, an east wind will come, the breath of the LORD coming up from the wilderness; and his spring will become dry, and his fountain will be dried up. He will plunder the storehouse of treasure. ¹⁶Samaria will bear her guilt, for she has rebelled against her God. They will fall by the sword. Their infants will be dashed in pieces, and their pregnant women will be ripped open.”

14Israel, return to the LORD your God; for you have fallen because of your sin. ²Take words with you, and return to the LORD. Tell him, “Forgive all our sins, and accept that which is good; so we offer bulls as we vowed of our lips. ³Assyria can’t save us. We won’t ride on horses; neither will we say any more to the work of our hands, ‘Our gods!’ for in you the fatherless finds mercy.” ⁴“I will heal their waywardness. I will love them freely; for my anger is turned away from them. ⁵I will be like the dew to Israel. He will blossom like the lily, and send down his roots like Lebanon. ⁶His branches will spread, and his beauty will be like the olive tree, and his fragrance like Lebanon. ⁷Men will dwell in his shade. They will revive like the grain, and blossom like the vine. Their fragrance will be like the wine of Lebanon. ⁸Ephraim, what have I to do any more with idols? I answer, and will take care of him. I am like a green cypress tree; from me your fruit is found.” ⁹Who is wise, that he may understand these things? Who is prudent, that he may know them? For the ways of the LORD are right, and the righteous walk in them, but the rebellious stumble in them.

^{ix}The word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

^xSheol is the place of the dead.

Joel

¹The LORD's ⁱ word that came to Joel, the son of Pethuel.
²Hear this, you elders, And listen, all you inhabitants of the land! Has this ever happened in your days, or in the days of your fathers? ³Tell your children about it, and have your children tell their children, and their children, another generation. ⁴What the swarming locust has left, the great locust has eaten. What the great locust has left, the grasshopper has eaten. What the grasshopper has left, the caterpillar has eaten. ⁵Wake up, you drunkards, and weep! Wail, all you drinkers of wine, because of the sweet wine, for it is cut off from your mouth. ⁶For a nation has come up on my land, strong, and without number. His teeth are the teeth of a lion, and he has the fangs of a lioness. ⁷He has laid my vine waste, and stripped my fig tree. He has stripped its bark, and thrown it away. Its branches are made white. ⁸Mourn like a virgin dressed in sackcloth for the husband of her youth! ⁹The meal offering and the drink offering are cut off from the LORD's house. The priests, the LORD's ministers, mourn. ¹⁰The field is laid waste. The land mourns, for the grain is destroyed, The new wine has dried up, and the oil languishes. ¹¹Be confounded, you farmers! Wail, you vineyard keepers, for the wheat and for the barley; for the harvest of the field has perished. ¹²The vine has dried up, and the fig tree withered—the pomegranate tree, the palm tree also, and the apple tree, even all of the trees of the field are withered; for joy has withered away from the sons of men. ¹³Put on sackcloth and mourn, you priests! Wail, you ministers of the altar. Come, lie all night in sackcloth, you ministers of my God, ⁱⁱ for the meal offering and the drink offering are withheld from your God's house. ¹⁴Sanctify a fast. Call a solemn assembly. Gather the elders and all the inhabitants of the land to the house of the LORD, your God, and cry to the LORD. ¹⁵Alas for the day! For the day of the LORD is at hand, and it will come as destruction from the Almighty. ¹⁶Isn't the food cut off before our eyes, joy and gladness from the house of our God? ¹⁷The seeds rot under their clods. The granaries are laid desolate. The barns are broken down, for the grain has withered. ¹⁸How

the animals groan! The herds of livestock are perplexed, because they have no pasture. Yes, the flocks of sheep are made desolate. ¹⁹The LORD, I cry to you, for the fire has devoured the pastures of the wilderness, and the flame has burned all the trees of the field. ²⁰Yes, the animals of the field pant to you, for the water brooks have dried up, and the fire has devoured the pastures of the wilderness.

²Blow the shofar in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain! Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble, for the day of the LORD comes, for it is close at hand: ²A day of darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness. As the dawn spreading on the mountains, a great and strong people; there has never been the like, neither will there be any more after them, even to the years of many generations. ³A fire devours before them, and behind them, a flame burns. The land is as the garden of Eden before them, and behind them, a desolate wilderness. Yes, and no one has escaped them. ⁴Their appearance is as the appearance of horses, and they run as horsemen. ⁵Like the noise of chariots on the tops of the mountains, they leap, like the noise of a flame of fire that devours the stubble, like a strong people set in battle array. ⁶At their presence the peoples are in anguish. All faces have grown pale. ⁷They run like mighty men. They climb the wall like warriors. They each march in his line, and they don't swerve off course. ⁸One doesn't jostle another. They each march in their own path. They burst through the defenses and don't break ranks. ⁹They rush on the city. They run on the wall. They climb up into the houses. They enter in at the windows like thieves. ¹⁰The earth quakes before them. The heavens tremble. The sun and the moon are darkened, and the stars withdraw their shining. ¹¹The LORD thunders his voice before his army, for his forces are very great; for he is strong who obeys his command; for the day of the LORD is great and very awesome, and who can endure it? ¹²"Yet even now," says the LORD, "turn to me with all your heart, and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning." ¹³Tear your heart and not your garments, and turn to the LORD, your God; for he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, and relents from sending calamity. ¹⁴Who knows? He may turn and relent, and leave a blessing

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

ing behind him, even a meal offering and a drink offering to the LORD, your God. ¹⁵Blow the shofar in Zion! Sanctify a fast. Call a solemn assembly. ¹⁶Gather the people. Sanctify the assembly. Assemble the elders. Gather the children, and those who nurse from breasts. Let the bridegroom go out of his room, and the bride out of her chamber. ¹⁷Let the priests, the ministers of the LORD, weep between the porch and the altar, and let them say, "Spare your people, LORD, and don't give your heritage to reproach, that the nations should rule over them. Why should they say among the peoples, 'Where is their God?'" ¹⁸Then the LORD was jealous for his land, And had pity on his people. ¹⁹The LORD answered his people, "Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I will send you grain, new wine, and oil, and you will be satisfied with them; and I will no more make you a reproach among the nations. ²⁰But I will remove the northern army far away from you, and will drive it into a barren and desolate land, its front into the eastern sea, and its back into the western sea; and its stench will come up, and its bad smell will rise." Surely he has done great things. ²¹Land, don't be afraid. Be glad and rejoice, for the LORD has done great things. ²²Don't be afraid, you animals of the field; for the pastures of the wilderness spring up, for the tree bears its fruit. The fig tree and the vine yield their strength. ²³"Be glad then, you children of Zion, and rejoice in the LORD, your God; for he gives you the early rain in just measure, and he causes the rain to come down for you, the early rain and the latter rain, as before. ²⁴The threshing floors will be full of wheat, and the vats will overflow with new wine and oil. ²⁵I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten, the great locust, the grasshopper, and the caterpillar, my great army, which I sent among you. ²⁶You will have plenty to eat and be satisfied, and will praise the name of the LORD, your God, who has dealt wondrously with you; and my people will never again be disappointed. ²⁷You will know that I am among Israel, and that I am the LORD, your God, and there is no one else; and my people will never again be disappointed. ²⁸"It will happen afterward, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh; and your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your old men will dream dreams. Your young men will see visions. ²⁹And also on the servants and on the handmaids in those days, I will pour out my Spirit. ³⁰I will show wonders in the heavens and in the earth: blood, fire, and pillars of smoke. ³¹The sun will be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the great and terrible day of the LORD comes. ³²It will happen that whoever will call on the LORD's name shall be saved; for in Mount Zion and in Jerusalem there will be those who escape, as the LORD has said, and among the remnant, those whom the LORD calls.

³"For, behold, in those days, and in that time, when I restore the fortunes of Judah and Jerusalem, ²I will gather all nations, and will bring them down into the valley of Jehoshaphat; and I will execute judgment on them there for my people, and for my heritage, Israel, whom they have scattered among the nations. They have divided my land, ³and have cast lots for my people, and have given a boy for a prostitute, and sold a girl for wine, that they may drink. ⁴"Yes, and what are you to me, Tyre and Sidon, and all the regions of Philistia? Will you repay me? And if you repay me, I will swiftly and speedily return your repayment on your own head. ⁵Because you have taken my silver and my gold, and have carried my finest treasures into your temples, ⁶and have sold the children of Judah and the children of Jerusalem to the sons of the Greeks, that you may remove them far from their border. ⁷Behold, I will stir them up out of the place where you have sold them, and will return your repayment on your own head; ⁸and I will sell your sons and your daughters into the hands of the children of Judah, and they will sell them to the men of Sheba, to a faraway nation, for the LORD has spoken it." ⁹Proclaim this among the nations: "Prepare for war! Stir up the mighty men. Let all the warriors draw near. Let them come up. ¹⁰Beat your plowshares into swords, and your pruning hooks into spears. Let the weak say, 'I am strong.' ¹¹Hurry and come, all you surrounding nations, and gather yourselves together." Cause your mighty ones to come down there, LORD. ¹²"Let the nations arouse themselves, and come up to the valley of Jehoshaphat; for there I will sit to judge all the surrounding nations. ¹³Put in the sickle; for the harvest is ripe. Come, tread, for the wine press is full, the vats overflow, for their wickedness is great." ¹⁴Multitudes, multitudes in the valley of decision! For the day of the LORD is near in the valley of decision. ¹⁵The sun and the moon are darkened, and the stars withdraw their shining. ¹⁶The LORD will roar from Zion, and thunder from Jerusalem; and the heavens and the earth will shake; but the LORD will be a refuge to his people, and a stronghold to the children of Israel. ¹⁷"So you will know that I am the LORD, your God, dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain. Then Jerusalem will be holy, and no strangers will pass through her any more. ¹⁸It will happen in that day, that the mountains will drop down sweet wine, the hills will flow with milk, all the brooks of Judah will flow with waters; and a fountain will flow out from the LORD's house, and will water the valley of Shittim. ¹⁹Egypt will be a desolation and Edom will be a desolate wilderness, for the violence done to the children of Judah, because they have shed innocent blood in their land. ²⁰But Judah will be inhabited forever, and Jerusalem from generation to generation. ²¹I will cleanse their blood that I have not cleansed, for the LORD dwells in Zion."

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Amos

¹The words of Amos, who was among the herdsmen of Tekoa, which he saw concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel, two years before the earthquake. ²He said: "The LORD ⁱ will roar from Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem; and the pastures of the shepherds will mourn, and the top of Carmel will wither." ³The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Damascus, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have threshed Gilead with threshing instruments of iron; ⁴but I will send a fire into the house of Hazael, and it will devour the palaces of Ben Hadad. ⁵I will break the bar of Damascus, and cut off the inhabitant from the valley of Aven, and him who holds the scepter from the house of Eden; and the people of Syria shall go into captivity to Kir," says the LORD. ⁶The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Gaza, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they carried away captive the whole community, to deliver them up to Edom; ⁷but I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza, and it will devour its palaces. ⁸I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod, and him who holds the scepter from Ashkelon; and I will turn my hand against Ekron; and the remnant of the Philistines will perish," says the Lord ⁱⁱ GOD. ⁹The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Tyre, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment; because they delivered up the whole community to Edom, and didn't remember the brotherly covenant; ¹⁰but I will send a fire on the wall of Tyre, and it will devour its palaces." ¹¹The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Edom, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because he pursued his brother with the sword and cast off all pity, and his anger raged continually, and he kept his wrath forever; ¹²but I will send a fire on Teman, and it will devour the palaces of Bozrah." ¹³The LORD says: "For three transgressions of the children of Ammon, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have ripped open the pregnant women of Gilead, that they may enlarge their border. ¹⁴But I will kindle a fire in the wall of Rabbah, and it will devour its palaces, with shout-

ing in the day of battle, with a storm in the day of the whirlwind; ¹⁵and their king will go into captivity, he and his princes together," says the LORD.

²The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Moab, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because he burned the bones of the king of Edom into lime; ²but I will send a fire on Moab, and it will devour the palaces of Kerioth; and Moab will die with tumult, with shouting, and with the sound of the shofar; ³and I will cut off the judge from among them, and will kill all its princes with him," says the LORD. ⁴The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Judah, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have rejected the LORD's law, and have not kept his statutes, and their lies have led them astray, after which their fathers walked; ⁵but I will send a fire on Judah, and it will devour the palaces of Jerusalem." ⁶The LORD says: "For three transgressions of Israel, yes, for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have sold the righteous for silver, and the needy for a pair of sandals; ⁷They trample the heads of the poor into the dust of the earth and deny justice to the oppressed. A man and his father use the same maiden, to profane my holy name. ⁸They lay themselves down beside every altar on clothes taken in pledge. In the house of their God ⁱⁱⁱ they drink the wine of those who have been fined. ⁹Yet I destroyed the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was strong as the oaks; yet I destroyed his fruit from above, and his roots from beneath. ¹⁰Also I brought you up out of the land of Egypt and led you forty years in the wilderness, to possess the land of the Amorite. ¹¹I raised up some of your sons for prophets, and some of your young men for Nazirites. Isn't this true, you children of Israel?" says the LORD. ¹²"But you gave the Nazirites wine to drink, and commanded the prophets, saying, 'Don't prophesy!' ¹³Behold, ^{iv} I will crush you in your place, as a cart crushes that is full of grain. ¹⁴Flight will perish from the swift. The strong won't strengthen his force. The mighty won't deliver himself. ¹⁵He who handles the bow won't stand. He who is swift of foot won't escape.

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^{iv}"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

He who rides the horse won't deliver himself. ¹⁶He who is courageous among the mighty will flee away naked on that day," says the LORD.

³Hear this word that the LORD has spoken against you, children of Israel, against the whole family which I brought up out of the land of Egypt, saying: ²"I have only chosen you of all the families of the earth. Therefore I will punish you for all of your sins." ³Do two walk together, unless they have agreed? ⁴Will a lion roar in the thicket, when he has no prey? Does a young lion cry out of his den, if he has caught nothing? ⁵Can a bird fall in a trap on the earth, where no snare is set for him? Does a snare spring up from the ground, when there is nothing to catch? ⁶Does the shofar alarm sound in a city, without the people being afraid? Does evil happen to a city, and the LORD hasn't done it? ⁷Surely the Lord GOD will do nothing, unless he reveals his secret to his servants the prophets. ⁸The lion has roared. Who will not fear? The Lord GOD has spoken. Who can but prophesy? ⁹Proclaim in the palaces at Ashdod, and in the palaces in the land of Egypt, and say, "Assemble yourselves on the mountains of Samaria, and see what unrest is in her, and what oppression is among them." ¹⁰"Indeed they don't know to do right," says the LORD, "Who hoard plunder and loot in their palaces." ¹¹Therefore the Lord GOD says: "An adversary will overrun the land; and he will pull down your strongholds, and your fortresses will be plundered." ¹²The LORD says: "As the shepherd rescues out of the mouth of the lion two legs, or a piece of an ear, so shall the children of Israel be rescued who sit in Samaria on the corner of a couch, and on the silken cushions of a bed." ¹³"Listen, and testify against the house of Jacob," says the Lord GOD, the God of Hosts. ¹⁴"For in the day that I visit the transgressions of Israel on him, I will also visit the altars of Bethel; and the horns of the altar will be cut off, and fall to the ground. ¹⁵I will strike the winter house with the summer house; and the houses of ivory will perish, and the great houses will have an end," says the LORD.

⁴Listen to this word, you cows of Bashan, who are on the mountain of Samaria, who oppress the poor, who crush the needy, who tell their husbands, "Bring us drinks!" ²The Lord GOD has sworn by his holiness, "Behold, the days shall come on you that they will take you away with hooks, and the last of you with fish hooks. ³You will go out at the breaks in the wall, everyone straight before her; and you will cast yourselves into Harmon," says the LORD. ⁴"Go to Bethel, and sin; to Gilgal, and sin more. Bring your sacrifices every morning, your tithes every three days, ⁵offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving of that which is leavened, and proclaim free will offerings and brag about them; for this pleases you, you children of Israel," says the Lord GOD. ⁶"I also have given you cleanness of teeth in all your

cities, and lack of bread in every town; yet you haven't returned to me," says the LORD. ⁷"I also have withheld the rain from you, when there were yet three months to the harvest; and I caused it to rain on one city, and caused it not to rain on another city. One field was rained on, and the field where it didn't rain withered. ⁸So two or three cities staggered to one city to drink water, and were not satisfied; yet you haven't returned to me," says the LORD. ⁹"I struck you with blight and mildew many times in your gardens and your vineyards, and the swarming locusts have devoured your fig trees and your olive trees; yet you haven't returned to me," says the LORD. ¹⁰"I sent plagues among you like I did Egypt. I have slain your young men with the sword, and have carried away your horses. I filled your nostrils with the stench of your camp, yet you haven't returned to me," says the LORD. ¹¹"I have overthrown some of you, as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and you were like a burning stick plucked out of the fire; yet you haven't returned to me," says the LORD. ¹²"Therefore I will do this to you, Israel; because I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, Israel. ¹³For, behold, he who forms the mountains, creates the wind, declares to man what is his thought, who makes the morning darkness, and treads on the high places of the earth: The LORD, the God of Hosts, is his name."

⁵Listen to this word which I take up for a lamentation over you, O house of Israel: ²"The virgin of Israel has fallen; She shall rise no more. She is cast down on her land; there is no one to raise her up." ³For the Lord GOD says: "The city that went out a thousand shall have a hundred left, and that which went out one hundred shall have ten left to the house of Israel." ⁴For the LORD says to the house of Israel: "Seek me, and you will live; ⁵but don't seek Bethel, nor enter into Gilgal, and don't pass to Beersheba; for Gilgal shall surely go into captivity, and Bethel shall come to nothing. ⁶Seek the LORD, and you will live, lest he break out like fire in the house of Joseph, and it devour, and there be no one to quench it in Bethel. ⁷You who turn justice to wormwood, and cast down righteousness to the earth! ⁸Seek him who made the Pleiades and Orion, and turns the shadow of death into the morning, and makes the day dark with night; who calls for the waters of the sea, and pours them out on the surface of the earth, the LORD is his name, ⁹who brings sudden destruction on the strong, so that destruction comes on the fortress. ¹⁰They hate him who reproves in the gate, and they abhor him who speaks blamelessly. ¹¹Therefore, because you trample on the poor and take taxes from him of wheat, you have built houses of cut stone, but you will not dwell in them. You have planted pleasant vineyards, but you shall not drink their wine. ¹²For I know how many are your offenses, and how great are your sins— you who afflict the just, who take a bribe, and who turn away the

needy in the courts. ¹³Therefore a prudent person keeps silent in such a time, for it is an evil time. ¹⁴Seek good, and not evil, that you may live; and so the LORD, the God of Hosts, will be with you, as you say. ¹⁵Hate evil, love good, and establish justice in the courts. It may be that the LORD, the God of Hosts, will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph.” ¹⁶Therefore the LORD, the God of Hosts, the Lord, says: “Wailing will be in all the wide ways. They will say in all the streets, ‘Alas! Alas!’ They will call the farmer to mourning, and those who are skillful in lamentation to wailing. ¹⁷In all vineyards there will be wailing, for I will pass through the middle of you,” says the LORD. ¹⁸“Woe to you who desire the day of the LORD! Why do you long for the day of the LORD? It is darkness, and not light. ¹⁹As if a man fled from a lion, and a bear met him; or he went into the house and leaned his hand on the wall, and a snake bit him. ²⁰Won’t the day of the LORD be darkness, and not light? Even very dark, and no brightness in it? ²¹I hate, I despise your feasts, and I can’t stand your solemn assemblies. ²²Yes, though you offer me your burnt offerings and meal offerings, I will not accept them; neither will I regard the peace offerings of your fat animals. ²³Take away from me the noise of your songs! I will not listen to the music of your harps. ²⁴But let justice roll on like rivers, and righteousness like a mighty stream. ²⁵“Did you bring to me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel? ²⁶You also carried the tent of your king and the shrine of your images, the star of your god, which you made for yourselves. ²⁷Therefore I will cause you to go into captivity beyond Damascus,” says the LORD, whose name is the God of Hosts.

⁶Woe to those who are at ease in Zion, and to those who are secure on the mountain of Samaria, the notable men of the chief of the nations, to whom the house of Israel come! ²Go to Calneh, and see. From there go to Hamath the great. Then go down to Gath of the Philistines. Are they better than these kingdoms? Is their border greater than your border? ³Alas for you who put far away the evil day, and cause the seat of violence to come near, ⁴who lie on beds of ivory, and stretch themselves on their couches, and eat the lambs out of the flock, and the calves out of the middle of the stall, ⁵who strum on the strings of a harp, who invent for themselves instruments of music, like David; ⁶who drink wine in bowls, and anoint themselves with the best oils, but they are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph. ⁷Therefore they will now go captive with the first who go captive. The feasting and lounging will end. ⁸“The Lord GOD has sworn by himself,” says the LORD, the God of Hosts: “I abhor the pride of Jacob, and detest his fortresses. Therefore I will deliver up the city with all that is in it. ⁹It will happen that if ten men remain in one house, they will die. ¹⁰“When a man’s relative carries him, even he who burns him, to bring bodies out of the

house, and asks him who is in the innermost parts of the house, ‘Is there yet any with you?’ And he says, ‘No;’ then he will say, ‘Hush! Indeed we must not mention the LORD’s name.’ ¹¹“For, behold, the LORD commands, and the great house will be smashed to pieces, and the little house into bits. ¹²Do horses run on the rocky crags? Does one plow there with oxen? But you have turned justice into poison, and the fruit of righteousness into bitterness, ¹³you who rejoice in a thing of nothing, who say, ‘Haven’t we taken for ourselves horns by our own strength?’ ¹⁴For, behold, I will raise up against you a nation, house of Israel,” says the LORD, the God of Hosts; “and they will afflict you from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of the Arabah.”

⁷Thus the Lord GOD showed me: behold, he formed locusts in the beginning of the shooting up of the latter growth; and behold, it was the latter growth after the king’s harvest. ²When they finished eating the grass of the land, then I said, “Lord GOD, forgive, I beg you! How could Jacob stand? For he is small.” ³The LORD relented concerning this. “It shall not be,” says the LORD. ⁴Thus the Lord GOD showed me: behold, the Lord GOD called for judgment by fire; and it dried up the great deep, and would have devoured the land. ⁵Then I said, “Lord GOD, stop, I beg you! How could Jacob stand? For he is small.” ⁶The LORD relented concerning this. “This also shall not be,” says the Lord GOD. ⁷Thus he showed me: behold, the Lord stood beside a wall made by a plumb line, with a plumb line in his hand. ⁸The LORD said to me, “Amos, what do you see?” I said, “A plumb line.” Then the Lord said, “Behold, I will set a plumb line in the middle of my people Israel. I will not again pass by them any more. ⁹The high places of Isaac will be desolate, the sanctuaries of Israel will be laid waste; and I will rise against the house of Jeroboam with the sword.” ¹⁰Then Amaziah the priest of Bethel sent to Jeroboam king of Israel, saying, “Amos has conspired against you in the middle of the house of Israel. The land is not able to bear all his words. ¹¹For Amos says, ‘Jeroboam will die by the sword, and Israel shall surely be led away captive out of his land.’” ¹²Amaziah also said to Amos, “You seer, go, flee away into the land of Judah, and there eat bread, and prophesy there, ¹³but don’t prophesy again any more at Bethel; for it is the king’s sanctuary, and it is a royal house!” ¹⁴Then Amos answered Amaziah, “I was no prophet, neither was I a prophet’s son, but I was a herdsman, and a farmer of sycamore figs; ¹⁵and the LORD took me from following the flock, and the LORD said to me, ‘Go, prophesy to my people Israel.’ ¹⁶Now therefore listen to the LORD’s word: ‘You say, Don’t prophesy against Israel, and don’t proclaim against the house of Isaac.’ ¹⁷Therefore the LORD says: ‘Your wife shall be a prostitute in the city, and your sons and your daughters shall fall by the sword, and your land shall be divided by line; and you yourself shall die in

a land that is unclean, and Israel shall surely be led away captive out of his land.”

⁸Thus the Lord GOD showed me: behold, a basket of summer fruit. ²He said, “Amos, what do you see?” I said, “A basket of summer fruit.” Then the LORD said to me, “The end has come on my people Israel. I will not again pass by them any more. ³The songs of the temple will be wailing in that day,” says the Lord GOD. “The dead bodies will be many. In every place they will throw them out with silence. ⁴Hear this, you who desire to swallow up the needy, and cause the poor of the land to fail, ⁵saying, ‘When will the new moon be gone, that we may sell grain? And the Sabbath, that we may market wheat, making the efah ^v small, and the shekel ^{vi} large, and dealing falsely with balances of deceit; ⁶that we may buy the poor for silver, and the needy for a pair of sandals, and sell the sweepings with the wheat?’” ⁷The LORD has sworn by the pride of Jacob, “Surely I will never forget any of their works. ⁸Won’t the land tremble for this, and everyone mourn who dwells in it? Yes, it will rise up wholly like the River; and it will be stirred up and sink again, like the River of Egypt. ⁹It will happen in that day,” says the Lord GOD, “that I will cause the sun to go down at noon, and I will darken the earth in the clear day. ¹⁰I will turn your feasts into mourning, and all your songs into lamentation; and I will make you wear sackcloth on all your bodies, and baldness on every head. I will make it like the mourning for an only son, and its end like a bitter day. ¹¹Behold, the days come,” says the Lord GOD, “that I will send a famine in the land, not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the LORD’s words. ¹²They will wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east; they will run back and forth to seek the LORD’s word, and will not find it. ¹³In that day the beautiful virgins and the young men will faint for thirst. ¹⁴Those who swear by the sin of Samaria, and say, ‘As your god, Dan, lives,’ and, ‘As the way of Beersheba lives,’ they will fall, and never rise up again.”

⁹I saw the Lord standing beside the altar, and he said, “Strike the tops of the pillars, that the thresholds may shake. Break them in pieces on the head of all of them. I will kill the last of them with the sword. Not one of them will flee away. Not one of them will escape. ²Though they dig into Sheol, ^{vii} there my hand will take them; and though they climb up to heaven, there I will bring them down. ³Though they hide themselves in the top of Carmel, I will search and take them out from there; and though they be hidden from my sight in the bottom of the sea, there I will command the serpent, and it will bite them.

⁴Though they go into captivity before their enemies, there I will command the sword, and it will kill them. I will set my eyes on them for evil, and not for good. ⁵For the Lord, the LORD of Hosts, is he who touches the land and it melts, and all who dwell in it will mourn; and it will rise up wholly like the River, and will sink again, like the River of Egypt. ⁶It is he who builds his rooms in the heavens, and has founded his vault on the earth; he who calls for the waters of the sea, and pours them out on the surface of the earth—the LORD is his name. ⁷Are you not like the children of the Ethiopians to me, children of Israel?” says the LORD. “Haven’t I brought up Israel out of the land of Egypt, and the Philistines from Caphtor, and the Syrians from Kir? ⁸Behold, the eyes of the Lord GOD are on the sinful kingdom, and I will destroy it from off the surface of the earth, except that I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob,” says the LORD. ⁹“For behold, I will command, and I will sift the house of Israel among all the nations as grain is sifted in a sieve, yet not the least kernel will fall on the earth. ¹⁰All the sinners of my people will die by the sword, who say, ‘Evil won’t overtake nor meet us.’ ¹¹In that day I will raise up the tent of David who is fallen and close up its breaches, and I will raise up its ruins, and I will build it as in the days of old, ¹²that they may possess the remnant of Edom and all the nations who are called by my name,” says the LORD who does this. ¹³“Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that the plowman shall overtake the reaper, and the one treading grapes him who sows seed; and sweet wine will drip from the mountains, and flow from the hills. ¹⁴I will bring my people Israel back from captivity, and they will rebuild the ruined cities, and inhabit them; and they will plant vineyards, and drink wine from them. They shall also make gardens, and eat their fruit. ¹⁵I will plant them on their land, and they will no more be plucked up out of their land which I have given them,” says the LORD your God.

^v1 efah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

^{vi}a normal shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{vii}Sheol is the place of the dead.

Obadiah

¹The vision of Obadiah. This is what the Lord ⁱ GOD ⁱⁱ says about Edom. We have heard news from the LORD, and an ambassador is sent among the nations, saying, “Arise, and let’s rise up against her in battle. ²Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I have made you small among the nations. You are greatly despised. ³The pride of your heart has deceived you, you who dwell in the clefts of the rock, whose habitation is high, who says in his heart, ‘Who will bring me down to the ground?’ ⁴Though you mount on high as the eagle, and though your nest is set among the stars, I will bring you down from there,” says the LORD. ⁵“If thieves came to you, if robbers by night—oh, what disaster awaits you—wouldn’t they only steal until they had enough? If grape pickers came to you, wouldn’t they leave some gleaning grapes? ⁶How Esau will be ransacked! How his hidden treasures are sought out! ⁷All the men of your alliance have brought you on your way, even to the border. The men who were at peace with you have deceived you, and prevailed against you. Friends who eat your bread lay a snare under you. There is no understanding in him.” ⁸“Won’t I in that day”, says the LORD, “destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mountain of Esau? ⁹Your mighty men, Teman, will be dismayed, to the end that everyone may be cut off from the mountain of Esau by slaughter. ¹⁰For the violence done to your brother Jacob, shame will cover you, and you will be cut off forever. ¹¹In the day that you stood on the other side, in the day that strangers carried away his substance and foreigners entered into his gates and cast lots for Jerusalem, even you were like one of them. ¹²But don’t look down on your brother in the day of his disaster, and don’t rejoice over the children of Judah in the day of their destruction. Don’t speak proudly in the day of distress. ¹³Don’t enter into the gate of my people in the day of their calamity. Don’t look down on their affliction in the day of their calamity, neither seize their wealth on the day of their calamity. ¹⁴Don’t stand in the crossroads to cut off those of his who escape. Don’t deliver up those of his who remain in the day of distress.

¹⁵For the day of the LORD is near all the nations! As you have done, it will be done to you. Your deeds will return upon your own head. ¹⁶For as you have drunk on my holy mountain, so all the nations will drink continually. Yes, they will drink, swallow down, and will be as though they had not been. ¹⁷But in Mount Zion, there will be those who escape, and it will be holy. The house of Jacob will possess their possessions. ¹⁸The house of Jacob will be a fire, the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau for stubble. They will burn among them and devour them. There will not be any remaining to the house of Esau.” Indeed, the LORD has spoken. ¹⁹Those of the South will possess the mountain of Esau, and those of the lowland, the Philistines. They will possess the field of Ephraim, and the field of Samaria. Benjamin will possess Gilead. ²⁰The captives of this army of the children of Israel, who are among the Canaanites, will possess even to Zarephath; and the captives of Jerusalem, who are in Sepharad, will possess the cities of the Negev. ²¹Saviors will go up on Mount Zion to judge the mountains of Esau, and the kingdom will be the LORD’s.

ⁱThe word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

ⁱⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, “LORD” or “GOD” is the translation of God’s Proper Name.

ⁱⁱⁱ“Behold”, from , “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Jonah

1Now the LORD's ⁱ word came to Jonah the son of Amitai, saying, ²"Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and proclaim against it, for their wickedness has come up before me." ³But Jonah rose up to flee to Tarshish from the presence of the LORD. He went down to Joppa, and found a ship going to Tarshish; so he paid its fare, and went down into it, to go with them to Tarshish from the presence of the LORD. ⁴But the LORD sent out a great wind on the sea, and there was a mighty storm on the sea, so that the ship was likely to break up. ⁵Then the mariners were afraid, and every man cried to his god. They threw the cargo that was in the ship into the sea to lighten the ship. But Jonah had gone down into the innermost parts of the ship and he was laying down, and was fast asleep. ⁶So the ship master came to him, and said to him, "What do you mean, sleeper? Arise, call on your God! ⁱⁱ Maybe your God ⁱⁱⁱ will notice us, so that we won't perish." ⁷They all said to each other, "Come! Let's cast lots, that we may know who is responsible for this evil that is on us." So they cast lots, and the lot fell on Jonah. ⁸Then they asked him, "Tell us, please, for whose cause this evil is on us. What is your occupation? Where do you come from? What is your country? Of what people are you?" ⁹He said to them, "I am a Hebrew, and I fear the LORD, the God ^{iv} of heaven, who has made the sea and the dry land." ¹⁰Then the men were exceedingly afraid, and said to him, "What have you done?" For the men knew that he was fleeing from the presence of the LORD, because he had told them. ¹¹Then they said to him, "What shall we do to you, that the sea may be calm to us?" For the sea grew more and more stormy. ¹²He said to them, "Take me up, and throw me into the sea. Then the sea will be calm for you; for I know that because of me this great storm is on you." ¹³Nevertheless the men rowed hard to get them back to the land; but they could not, for the sea grew more and more stormy against them. ¹⁴Therefore they cried to the LORD, and said, "We beg you, LORD, we beg you, don't let us die for this man's life, and don't lay on us innocent

blood; for you, LORD, have done as it pleased you." ¹⁵So they took up Jonah and threw him into the sea; and the sea ceased its raging. ¹⁶Then the men feared the LORD exceedingly; and they offered a sacrifice to the LORD and made vows. ¹⁷The LORD prepared a huge fish to swallow up Jonah, and Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.

2Then Jonah prayed to the LORD, his God, out of the fish's belly. ²He said, "I called because of my affliction to the LORD. He answered me. Out of the belly of Sheol ^v I cried. You heard my voice. ³For you threw me into the depths, in the heart of the seas. The flood was all around me. All your waves and your billows passed over me. ⁴I said, 'I have been banished from your sight; yet I will look again toward your holy temple.' ⁵The waters surrounded me, even to the soul. The deep was around me. The weeds were wrapped around my head. ⁶I went down to the bottoms of the mountains. The earth barred me in forever; yet you have brought my life up from the pit, LORD my God. ⁷"When my soul fainted within me, I remembered the LORD. My prayer came in to you, into your holy temple. ⁸Those who regard vain idols forsake their own mercy. ⁹But I will sacrifice to you with the voice of thanksgiving. I will pay that which I have vowed. Salvation belongs to the LORD." ¹⁰Then The LORD spoke to the fish, and it vomited out Jonah on the dry land.

3The LORD's word came to Jonah the second time, saying, ²"Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and proclaim to it the message that I give you." ³So Jonah arose, and went to Nineveh, according to the LORD's word. Now Nineveh was an exceedingly great city, three days' journey across. ⁴Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried out, and said, "In forty days, Nineveh will be overthrown!" ⁵The people of Nineveh believed God; and they proclaimed a fast and put on sackcloth, from their greatest even to their least. ⁶The news reached the king of Nineveh, and he arose from his throne, took off his royal robe, covered himself with sackcloth, and sat in ashes. ⁷He made a proclamation and published through Nineveh by

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ⁱⁱor, gods

ⁱⁱⁱor, gods

^{iv}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

^vSheol is the place of the dead.

the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, "Let neither man nor animal, herd nor flock, taste anything; let them not feed, nor drink water; ⁸but let them be covered with sackcloth, both man and animal, and let them cry mightily to God. Yes, let them turn everyone from his evil way and from the violence that is in his hands. ⁹Who knows whether God will not turn and relent, and turn away from his fierce anger, so that we might not perish?" ¹⁰God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way. God relented of the disaster which he said he would do to them, and he didn't do it.

⁴But it displeased Jonah exceedingly, and he was angry. ²He prayed to the LORD, and said, "Please, LORD, wasn't this what I said when I was still in my own country? Therefore I hurried to flee to Tarshish, for I knew that you are a gracious God and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, and you relent of doing harm. ³Therefore now, LORD, take, I beg you, my life from me, for it is better for me to die than to live." ⁴The LORD said, "Is it right for you to be angry?" ⁵Then Jonah went out of the city and sat on the east side of the city, and there made himself a booth and sat under it in the shade, until he might see what would become of the city. ⁶The LORD God prepared a vine and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shade over his head to deliver him from his discomfort. So Jonah was exceedingly glad because of the vine. ⁷But God prepared a worm at dawn the next day, and it chewed on the vine so that it withered. ⁸When the sun arose, God prepared a sultry east wind; and the sun beat on Jonah's head, so that he was faint and requested for himself that he might die. He said, "It is better for me to die than to live." ⁹God said to Jonah, "Is it right for you to be angry about the vine?" He said, "I am right to be angry, even to death." ¹⁰The LORD said, "You have been concerned for the vine, for which you have not labored, neither made it grow; which came up in a night and perished in a night. ¹¹Shouldn't I be concerned for Nineveh, that great city, in which are more than one hundred twenty thousand persons who can't discern between their right hand and their left hand, and also many animals?"

Micah

1The LORD's ⁱ word that came to Micah of Morasheth in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem. ²Hear, you peoples, all of you! Listen, O earth, and all that is therein. Let the Lord ⁱⁱ GOD be witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple. ³For behold, ⁱⁱⁱ the LORD comes out of his place, and will come down and tread on the high places of the earth. ⁴The mountains melt under him, and the valleys split apart like wax before the fire, like waters that are poured down a steep place. ⁵"All this is for the disobedience of Jacob, and for the sins of the house of Israel. What is the disobedience of Jacob? Isn't it Samaria? And what are the high places of Judah? Aren't they Jerusalem?" ⁶Therefore I will make Samaria like a rubble heap of the field, like places for planting vineyards; and I will pour down its stones into the valley, and I will uncover its foundations. ⁷All her idols will be beaten to pieces, all her temple gifts will be burned with fire, and I will destroy all her images; for of the hire of a prostitute has she gathered them, and to the hire of a prostitute shall they return." ⁸For this I will lament and wail. I will go stripped and naked. I will howl like the jackals and mourn like the ostriches. ⁹For her wounds are incurable; for it has come even to Judah. It reaches to the gate of my people, even to Jerusalem. ¹⁰Don't tell it in Gath. Don't weep at all. At Beth Ophrah ^{iv} I have rolled myself in the dust. ¹¹Pass on, inhabitant of Shaphir, in nakedness and shame. The inhabitant of Zaanan won't come out. The wailing of Beth Ezel will take from you his protection. ¹²For the inhabitant of Maroth waits anxiously for good, because evil has come down from the LORD to the gate of Jerusalem. ¹³Harness the chariot to the swift steed, inhabitant of Lachish. She was the beginning of sin to the daughter of Zion; For the transgressions of Israel were found in you. ¹⁴Therefore you will give a parting gift to Moresheth Gath. The houses of Achzib will be a deceitful thing to the kings of Israel. ¹⁵I will yet bring a conqueror

to you, inhabitants of Mareshah. The glory of Israel will come to Adullam. ¹⁶Shave your heads, and cut off your hair for the children of your delight. Enlarge your baldness like the vulture, for they have gone into captivity from you!

2Woe to those who devise iniquity and work evil on their beds! When the morning is light, they practice it, because it is in the power of their hand. ²They covet fields and seize them, and houses, then take them away. They oppress a man and his house, even a man and his heritage. ³Therefore the LORD says: "Behold, I am planning against these people a disaster, from which you will not remove your necks, neither will you walk haughtily, for it is an evil time. ⁴In that day they will take up a parable against you, and lament with a doleful lamentation, saying, 'We are utterly ruined! My people's possession is divided up. Indeed he takes it from me and assigns our fields to traitors!'" ⁵Therefore you will have no one who divides the land by lot in the LORD's assembly. ⁶"Don't prophesy!"—they prophesy—"Don't prophesy about these things. Disgrace won't overtake us." ⁷Shall it be said, O house of Jacob, "Is the LORD's Spirit angry? Are these his doings? Don't my words do good to him who walks blamelessly?" ⁸But lately my people have risen up as an enemy. You strip the robe and clothing from those who pass by without a care, returning from battle. ⁹You drive the women of my people out from their pleasant houses; from their young children you take away my blessing forever. ¹⁰Arise, and depart! For this is not your resting place, because of uncleanness that destroys, even with a grievous destruction. ¹¹If a man walking in a spirit of falsehood lies, saying, "I will prophesy to you of wine and of strong drink," he would be the prophet of this people. ¹²I will surely assemble all of you, Jacob. I will surely gather the remnant of Israel. I will put them together as the sheep of Bozrah, as a flock in the middle of their pasture. They will swarm with people. ¹³He who breaks open the way goes up before them. They break through the gate, and go out. Their king passes on before them, with the LORD at their head.

3I said, "Please listen, you heads of Jacob, and rulers of the house of Israel: Isn't it for you to know justice? ²You who hate the good, and love the evil; who tear off their

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^{iv}Beth Ophrah means literally "House of Dust."

skin, and their flesh from off their bones; ³who also eat the flesh of my people, and peel their skin from off them, and break their bones, and chop them in pieces, as for the pot, and as meat within the cauldron. ⁴Then they will cry to the LORD, but he will not answer them. Yes, he will hide his face from them at that time, because they made their deeds evil.” ⁵The LORD says concerning the prophets who lead my people astray—for those who feed their teeth, they proclaim, “Peace!” and whoever doesn’t provide for their mouths, they prepare war against him: ⁶“Therefore night is over you, with no vision, and it is dark to you, that you may not divine; and the sun will go down on the prophets, and the day will be black over them. ⁷The seers shall be disappointed, and the diviners confounded. Yes, they shall all cover their lips, for there is no answer from God.” ^v ⁸But as for me, I am full of power by the LORD’s Spirit, and of judgment, and of might, to declare to Jacob his disobedience, and to Israel his sin. ⁹Please listen to this, you heads of the house of Jacob, and rulers of the house of Israel, who abhor justice, and pervert all equity, ¹⁰who build up Zion with blood, and Jerusalem with iniquity. ¹¹Her leaders judge for bribes, and her priests teach for a price, and her prophets of it tell fortunes for money; yet they lean on the LORD, and say, “Isn’t the LORD among us? No disaster will come on us.” ¹²Therefore Zion for your sake will be plowed like a field, and Jerusalem will become heaps of rubble, and the mountain of the temple like the high places of a forest.

⁴But in the latter days, it will happen that the mountain of the LORD’s temple will be established on the top of the mountains, and it will be exalted above the hills; and peoples will stream to it. ²Many nations will go and say, “Come! Let’s go up to the mountain of the LORD, and to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths.” For the law will go out of Zion, and the LORD’s word from Jerusalem; ³and he will judge between many peoples, and will decide concerning strong nations afar off. They will beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will not lift up sword against nation, neither will they learn war any more. ⁴But every man will sit under his vine and under his fig tree. No one will make them afraid, for the mouth of the LORD of Hosts has spoken. ⁵Indeed all the nations may walk in the name of their gods, but we will walk in the name of the LORD our God forever and ever. ⁶“In that day,” says the LORD, “I will assemble that which is lame, and I will gather that which is driven away, and that which I have afflicted; ⁷and I will make that which was lame a remnant, and that which was cast far off a strong nation: and the LORD will reign over them on Mount Zion from then on, even forever.” ⁸You, tower of the flock, the hill of the daughter of Zion, to you it will

come. Yes, the former dominion will come, the kingdom of the daughter of Jerusalem. ⁹Now why do you cry out aloud? Is there no king in you? Has your counselor perished, that pains have taken hold of you as of a woman in travail? ¹⁰Be in pain, and labor to give birth, daughter of Zion, like a woman in travail; for now you will go out of the city, and will dwell in the field, and will come even to Babylon. There you will be rescued. There the LORD will redeem you from the hand of your enemies. ¹¹Now many nations have assembled against you, that say, “Let her be defiled, and let our eye gloat over Zion.” ¹²But they don’t know the thoughts of the LORD, neither do they understand his counsel; for he has gathered them like the sheaves to the threshing floor. ¹³Arise and thresh, daughter of Zion, for I will make your horn iron, and I will make your hoofs bronze. You will beat in pieces many peoples. I will devote their gain to the LORD, and their substance to the Lord of the whole earth.

⁵Now you shall gather yourself in troops, daughter of troops. He has laid siege against us. They will strike the judge of Israel with a rod on the cheek. ²But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, being small among the clans of Judah, out of you one will come out to me who is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings out are from of old, from ancient times. ³Therefore he will abandon them until the time that she who is in labor gives birth. Then the rest of his brothers will return to the children of Israel. ⁴He shall stand, and shall shepherd in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD his God. They will live, for then he will be great to the ends of the earth. ⁵He will be our peace when Assyria invades our land and when he marches through our fortresses, then we will raise against him seven shepherds, and eight leaders of men. ⁶They will rule the land of Assyria with the sword, and the land of Nimrod in its gates. He will deliver us from the Assyrian, when he invades our land, and when he marches within our border. ⁷The remnant of Jacob will be among many peoples like dew from the LORD, like showers on the grass, that don’t wait for man nor wait for the sons of men. ⁸The remnant of Jacob will be among the nations, among many peoples, like a lion among the animals of the forest, like a young lion among the flocks of sheep; who, if he goes through, treads down and tears in pieces, and there is no one to deliver. ⁹Let your hand be lifted up above your adversaries, and let all of your enemies be cut off. ¹⁰“It will happen in that day,” says the LORD, “that I will cut off your horses from among you and will destroy your chariots. ¹¹I will cut off the cities of your land and will tear down all your strongholds. ¹²I will destroy witchcraft from your hand. You shall have no soothsayers. ¹³I will cut off your engraved images and your pillars from among you; and you shall no more worship the work of your hands. ¹⁴I will uproot your Asherah poles from among you; and I will de-

^vThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is “ (Elohim).

stroy your cities. ¹⁵I will execute vengeance in anger and wrath on the nations that didn't listen."

6Listen now to what the LORD says: "Arise, plead your case before the mountains, and let the hills hear what you have to say. ²Hear, you mountains, the LORD's indictment, and you enduring foundations of the earth; for the LORD has a case against his people, and he will contend with Israel. ³My people, what have I done to you? How have I burdened you? Answer me! ⁴For I brought you up out of the land of Egypt, and redeemed you out of the house of bondage. I sent before you Moses, Aaron, and Miriam. ⁵My people, remember now what Balak king of Moab devised, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered him from Shittim to Gilgal, that you may know the righteous acts of the LORD." ⁶How shall I come before the LORD, and bow myself before the exalted God? Shall I come before him with burnt offerings, with calves a year old? ⁷Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams? With tens of thousands of rivers of oil? Shall I give my firstborn for my disobedience? The fruit of my body for the sin of my soul? ⁸He has shown you, O man, what is good. What does the LORD require of you, but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God? ⁹The LORD's voice calls to the city— and wisdom fears your name— "Listen to the rod, and he who appointed it. ¹⁰Are there yet treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and a short ephah ^{vi} that is accursed? ¹¹Shall I tolerate dishonest scales, and a bag of deceitful weights? ¹²Her rich men are full of violence, her inhabitants speak lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their speech. ¹³Therefore I also have struck you with a grievous wound. I have made you desolate because of your sins. ¹⁴You shall eat, but not be satisfied. Your hunger will be within you. You will store up, but not save, and that which you save I will give up to the sword. ¹⁵You will sow, but won't reap. You will tread the olives, but won't anoint yourself with oil; and crush grapes, but won't drink the wine. ¹⁶For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of Ahab's house. You walk in their counsels, that I may make you a ruin, and your inhabitants a hissing. You will bear the reproach of my people."

7Misery is mine! Indeed, I am like one who gathers the summer fruits, as gleanings of the vineyard. There is no cluster of grapes to eat. My soul desires to eat the early fig. ²The godly man has perished out of the earth, and there is no one upright among men. They all lie in wait for blood; every man hunts his brother with a net. ³Their hands are on that which is evil to do it diligently. The ruler and judge ask for a bribe. The powerful man dictates the evil desire

of his soul. Thus they conspire together. ⁴The best of them is like a brier. The most upright is worse than a thorn hedge. The day of your watchmen, even your visitation, has come; now is the time of their confusion. ⁵Don't trust in a neighbor. Don't put confidence in a friend. With the woman lying in your embrace, be careful of the words of your mouth! ⁶For the son dishonors the father, the daughter rises up against her mother, the daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law; a man's enemies are the men of his own house. ⁷But as for me, I will look to the LORD. I will wait for the God of my salvation. My God will hear me. ⁸Don't rejoice against me, my enemy. When I fall, I will arise. When I sit in darkness, the LORD will be a light to me. ⁹I will bear the indignation of the LORD, because I have sinned against him, until he pleads my case and executes judgment for me. He will bring me out to the light. I will see his righteousness. ¹⁰Then my enemy will see it, and shame will cover her who said to me, "Where is the LORD your God?" My eyes will see her. Now she will be trodden down like the mire of the streets. ¹¹A day to build your walls! In that day, he will extend your boundary. ¹²In that day they will come to you from Assyria and the cities of Egypt, and from Egypt even to the River, and from sea to sea, and mountain to mountain. ¹³Yet the land will be desolate because of those who dwell therein, for the fruit of their doings. ¹⁴Shepherd your people with your staff, the flock of your heritage, who dwell by themselves in a forest. Let them feed in the middle of fertile pasture land, in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old. ¹⁵"As in the days of your coming out of the land of Egypt, I will show them marvelous things." ¹⁶The nations will see and be ashamed of all their might. They will lay their hand on their mouth. Their ears will be deaf. ¹⁷They will lick the dust like a serpent. Like crawling things of the earth, they will come trembling out of their dens. They will come with fear to the LORD our God, and will be afraid because of you. ¹⁸Who is a God like you, who pardons iniquity, and passes over the disobedience of the remnant of his heritage? He doesn't retain his anger forever, because he delights in loving kindness. ¹⁹He will again have compassion on us. He will tread our iniquities under foot. You will cast all their sins into the depths of the sea. ²⁰You will give truth to Jacob, and mercy to Abraham, as you have sworn to our fathers from the days of old.

^{vi}An ephah is a measure of volume (about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel), and a short ephah is made smaller than a full ephah for the purpose of cheating customers.

Nahum

1A revelation about Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite. ²The LORD ⁱ is a jealous God ⁱⁱ and avenges. The LORD avenges and is full of wrath. The LORD takes vengeance on his adversaries, and he maintains wrath against his enemies. ³The LORD is slow to anger, and great in power, and will by no means leave the guilty unpunished. The LORD has his way in the whirlwind and in the storm, and the clouds are the dust of his feet. ⁴He rebukes the sea and makes it dry, and dries up all the rivers. Bashan and Carmel languish. The flower of Lebanon languishes. ⁵The mountains quake before him, and the hills melt away. The earth trembles at his presence, yes, the world, and all who dwell in it. ⁶Who can stand before his indignation? Who can endure the fierceness of his anger? His wrath is poured out like fire, and the rocks are broken apart by him. ⁷The LORD is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; and he knows those who take refuge in him. ⁸But with an overflowing flood, he will make a full end of her place, and will pursue his enemies into darkness. ⁹What do you plot against the LORD? He will make a full end. Affliction won't rise up the second time. ¹⁰For entangled like thorns, and drunken as with their drink, they are consumed utterly like dry stubble. ¹¹One has gone out of you who devises evil against the LORD, who counsels wickedness. ¹²The LORD says: "Though they are in full strength and likewise many, even so they will be cut down and pass away. Though I have afflicted you, I will afflict you no more. ¹³Now I will break his yoke from off you, and will burst your bonds apart." ¹⁴The LORD has commanded concerning you: "No more descendants will bear your name. Out of the house of your gods, I will cut off the engraved image and the molten image. I will make your grave, for you are vile." ¹⁵Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ on the mountains the feet of him who brings good news, who publishes peace! Keep your feasts, Judah! Perform your vows, for the wicked one will no more pass through you. He is utterly cut off.

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ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim".

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

2He who dashes in pieces has come up against you. Keep the fortress! Watch the way! Strengthen your waist! Fortify your power mightily! ²For the LORD restores the excellency of Jacob as the excellency of Israel, for the destroyers have destroyed them and ruined their vine branches. ³The shield of his mighty men is made red. The valiant men are in scarlet. The chariots flash with steel in the day of his preparation, and the pine spears are brandished. ⁴The chariots rage in the streets. They rush back and forth in the wide ways. Their appearance is like torches. They run like the lightnings. ⁵He summons his picked troops. They stumble on their way. They dash to its wall, and the protective shield is put in place. ⁶The gates of the rivers are opened, and the palace is dissolved. ⁷It is decreed: she is uncovered, she is carried away; and her servants moan as with the voice of doves, beating on their breasts. ⁸But Nineveh has been from of old like a pool of water, yet they flee away. "Stop! Stop!" they cry, but no one looks back. ⁹Take the plunder of silver. Take the plunder of gold, for there is no end of treasure, an abundance of every precious thing. ¹⁰She is empty, void, and waste. The heart melts, the knees knock together, their bodies and faces have grown pale. ¹¹Where is the den of the lions, and the feeding place of the young lions, where the lion and the lioness walked with the lion's cubs, and no one made them afraid? ¹²The lion tore in pieces enough for his cubs, and strangled prey for his lionesses, and filled his caves with the kill and his dens with prey. ¹³"Behold, I am against you," says the LORD of Hosts, "and I will burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword will devour your young lions; and I will cut off your prey from the earth, and the voice of your messengers will no longer be heard."

3Woe to the bloody city! It is all full of lies and robbery—no end to the prey. ²The noise of the whip, the noise of the rattling of wheels, prancing horses, and bounding chariots, ³the horseman charging, and the flashing sword, the glittering spear, and a multitude of slain, and a great heap of corpses, and there is no end of the bodies. They stumble on their bodies ⁴because of the multitude of the prostitution of the alluring prostitute, the mistress of witchcraft, who sells nations through her prostitution, and families

through her witchcraft. ⁵“Behold, I am against you,” says the LORD of Hosts, “and I will lift your skirts over your face. I will show the nations your nakedness, and the kingdoms your shame. ⁶I will throw abominable filth on you and make you vile, and will make you a spectacle. ⁷It will happen that all those who look at you will flee from you, and say, ‘Nineveh is laid waste! Who will mourn for her?’ Where will I seek comforters for you?” ⁸Are you better than No-Amon, ^{iv} who was situated among the rivers, ^v who had the waters around her, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was of the sea? ⁹Cush and Egypt were her boundless strength. Put and Libya were her helpers. ¹⁰Yet was she carried away. She went into captivity. Her young children also were dashed in pieces at the head of all the streets, and they cast lots for her honorable men, and all her great men were bound in chains. ¹¹You also will be drunken. You will be hidden. You also will seek a stronghold because of the enemy. ¹²All your fortresses will be like fig trees with the first-ripe figs. If they are shaken, they fall into the mouth of the eater. ¹³Behold, your troops among you are women. The gates of your land are set wide open to your enemies. The fire has devoured your bars. ¹⁴Draw water for the siege. Strengthen your fortresses. Go into the clay, and tread the mortar. Make the brick kiln strong. ¹⁵There the fire will devour you. The sword will cut you off. It will devour you like the grasshopper. Multiply like grasshoppers. Multiply like the locust. ¹⁶You have increased your merchants more than the stars of the skies. The grasshopper strips and flees away. ¹⁷Your guards are like the locusts, and your officials like the swarms of locusts, which settle on the walls on a cold day, but when the sun appears, they flee away, and their place is not known where they are. ¹⁸Your shepherds slumber, king of Assyria. Your nobles lie down. Your people are scattered on the mountains, and there is no one to gather them. ¹⁹There is no healing your wound, for your injury is fatal. All who hear the report of you clap their hands over you, for who hasn’t felt your endless cruelty?

^{iv}or, Thebes

^vor, Nile

Habakkuk

¹The revelation which Habakkuk the prophet saw. ²LORD, nations without mercy?

ⁱ how long will I cry, and you will not hear? I cry out to you “Violence!” and will you not save? ³Why do you show me iniquity, and look at perversity? For destruction and violence are before me. There is strife, and contention rises up. ⁴Therefore the law is paralyzed, and justice never prevails; for the wicked surround the righteous; therefore justice comes out perverted. ⁵“Look among the nations, watch, and wonder marvelously; for I am working a work in your days which you will not believe though it is told you. ⁶For, behold, ⁱⁱ I am raising up the Kasdim, that bitter and hasty nation who march through the width of the earth, to possess dwelling places that are not theirs. ⁷They are feared and dreaded. Their judgment and their dignity proceed from themselves. ⁸Their horses also are swifter than leopards, and are more fierce than the evening wolves. Their horsemen press proudly on. Yes, their horsemen come from afar. They fly as an eagle that hurries to devour. ⁹All of them come for violence. Their hordes face forward. They gather prisoners like sand. ¹⁰Yes, they scoff at kings, and princes are a derision to them. They laugh at every stronghold, for they build up an earthen ramp and take it. ¹¹Then they sweep by like the wind and go on. They are indeed guilty, whose strength is their god.” ¹²Aren’t you from everlasting, LORD my God, ⁱⁱⁱ my Holy One? We will not die. LORD, you have appointed them for judgment. You, Rock, have established him to punish. ¹³You who have purer eyes than to see evil, and who cannot look on perversity, why do you tolerate those who deal treacherously and keep silent when the wicked swallows up the man who is more righteous than he, ¹⁴and make men like the fish of the sea, like the creeping things that have no ruler over them? ¹⁵He takes up all of them with the hook. He catches them in his net and gathers them in his dragnet. Therefore he rejoices and is glad. ¹⁶Therefore he sacrifices to his net and burns incense to his dragnet, because by them his life is luxurious and his food is good. ¹⁷Will he therefore continually empty his net, and kill the

²I will stand at my watch and set myself on the ramparts, and will look out to see what he will say to me, and what I will answer concerning my complaint. ²The LORD answered me, “Write the vision, and make it plain on tablets, that he who runs may read it. ³For the vision is yet for the appointed time, and it hurries toward the end, and won’t prove false. Though it takes time, wait for it, because it will surely come. It won’t delay. ⁴Behold, his soul is puffed up. It is not upright in him, but the righteous will live by his faith. ⁵Yes, moreover, wine is treacherous: an arrogant man who doesn’t stay at home, who enlarges his desire as Sheol; ^{iv} he is like death and can’t be satisfied, but gathers to himself all nations and heaps to himself all peoples. ⁶Won’t all these take up a parable against him, and a taunting proverb against him, and say, ‘Woe to him who increases that which is not his, and who enriches himself by extortion! How long?’ ⁷Won’t your debtors rise up suddenly, and wake up those who make you tremble, and you will be their victim? ⁸Because you have plundered many nations, all the remnant of the peoples will plunder you because of men’s blood, and for the violence done to the land, to the city and to all who dwell in it. ⁹Woe to him who gets an evil gain for his house, that he may set his nest on high, that he may be delivered from the hand of evil! ¹⁰You have devised shame to your house by cutting off many peoples, and have sinned against your soul. ¹¹For the stone will cry out of the wall, and the beam out of the woodwork will answer it. ¹²Woe to him who builds a town with blood, and establishes a city by iniquity! ¹³Behold, isn’t it from the LORD of Hosts that the peoples labor for the fire, and the nations weary themselves for vanity? ¹⁴For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the LORD’s glory, as the waters cover the sea. ¹⁵“Woe to him who gives his neighbor drink, pouring your inflaming wine until they are drunk, so that you may gaze at their naked bodies! ¹⁶You are filled with shame, and not glory. You will also drink and be exposed! The cup of the LORD’s right hand will come around to you, and disgrace will cover your glory. ¹⁷For the violence done to

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ⁱⁱ“Behold”, from ,” “ means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered “God” is ” “ (Elohim).

^{iv}Sheol is the place of the dead.

Lebanon will overwhelm you, and the destruction of the animals will terrify you, because of men's blood and for the violence done to the land, to every city and to those who dwell in them. ¹⁸“What value does the engraved image have, that its maker has engraved it; the molten image, even the teacher of lies, that he who fashions its form trusts in it, to make mute idols? ¹⁹Woe to him who says to the wood, ‘Awake!’ or to the mute stone, ‘Arise!’ Shall this teach? Behold, it is overlaid with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all within it. ²⁰But the LORD is in his holy temple. Let all the earth be silent before him!”

3A prayer of Habakkuk, the prophet, set to victorious music. ²LORD, I have heard of your fame. I stand in awe of your deeds, LORD. Renew your work in the middle of the years. In the middle of the years make it known. In wrath, you remember mercy. ³God came from Teman, the Holy One from Mount Paran. Selah. His glory covered the heavens, and his praise filled the earth. ⁴His splendor is like the sunrise. Rays shine from his hand, where his power is hidden. ⁵Plague went before him, and pestilence followed his feet. ⁶He stood, and shook the earth. He looked, and made the nations tremble. The ancient mountains were crumbled. The age-old hills collapsed. His ways are eternal. ⁷I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction. The dwellings of the land of Midian trembled. ⁸Was the LORD displeased with the rivers? Was your anger against the rivers, or your wrath against the sea, that you rode on your horses, on your chariots of salvation? ⁹You uncovered your bow. You called for your sworn arrows. Selah. You split the earth with rivers. ¹⁰The mountains saw you, and were afraid. The storm of waters passed by. The deep roared and lifted up its hands on high. ¹¹The sun and moon stood still in the sky at the light of your arrows as they went, at the shining of your glittering spear. ¹²You marched through the land in wrath. You threshed the nations in anger. ¹³You went out for the salvation of your people, for the salvation of your anointed. You crushed the head of the land of wickedness. You stripped them head to foot. Selah. ¹⁴You pierced the heads of his warriors with their own spears. They came as a whirlwind to scatter me, gloating as if to devour the wretched in secret. ¹⁵You trampled the sea with your horses, churning mighty waters. ¹⁶I heard, and my body trembled. My lips quivered at the voice. Rottenness enters into my bones, and I tremble in my place because I must wait quietly for the day of trouble, for the coming up of the people who invade us. ¹⁷For even though the fig tree doesn't flourish, nor fruit be in the vines, the labor of the olive fails, the fields yield no food, the flocks are cut off from the fold, and there is no herd in the stalls, ¹⁸yet I will rejoice in the LORD. I will be joyful in the God of my salvation! ¹⁹The LORD, the Lord, ^v is my strength. He makes my feet like

deer's feet, and enables me to go in high places. For the music director, on my stringed instruments.

^vThe word translated “Lord” (mixed case) is “Adonai.”

Zephaniah

¹The LORD's ⁱ word which came to Zephaniah, the son of Cushi, the son of Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of Hezekiah, in the days of Josiah, the son of Amon, king of Judah. ²I will utterly sweep away everything from the surface of the earth, says the LORD. ³I will sweep away man and animal. I will sweep away the birds of the sky, the fish of the sea, and the heaps of rubble with the wicked. I will cut off man from the surface of the earth, says the LORD. ⁴I will stretch out my hand against Judah and against all the inhabitants of Jerusalem. I will cut off the remnant of Baal from this place—the name of the idolatrous and pagan priests, ⁵those who worship the army of the sky on the housetops, those who worship and swear by the LORD and also swear by Molech, ⁶those who have turned back from following the LORD, and those who haven't sought the LORD nor inquired after him. ⁷Be silent at the presence of the Lord ⁱⁱ GOD, for the day of the LORD is at hand. For the LORD has prepared a sacrifice. He has consecrated his guests. ⁸It will happen in the day of the LORD's sacrifice that I will punish the princes, the king's sons, and all those who are clothed with foreign clothing. ⁹In that day, I will punish all those who leap over the threshold, who fill their master's house with violence and deceit. ¹⁰In that day, says the LORD, there will be the noise of a cry from the fish gate, a wailing from the second quarter, and a great crashing from the hills. ¹¹Wail, you inhabitants of Maktesh, for all the people of Canaan are undone! All those who were loaded with silver are cut off. ¹²It will happen at that time, that I will search Jerusalem with lamps, and I will punish the men who are settled on their dregs, who say in their heart, "The LORD will not do good, neither will he do evil." ¹³Their wealth will become a plunder, and their houses a desolation. Yes, they will build houses, but won't inhabit them. They will plant vineyards, but won't drink their wine. ¹⁴The great day of the LORD is near. It is near and hurries greatly, the voice of the day of the LORD. The mighty man cries there bitterly. ¹⁵That day is a day of wrath, a day of distress and anguish, a day of trouble and ruin, a day of darkness

and gloom, a day of clouds and blackness, ¹⁶a day of the shofar and alarm against the fortified cities and against the high battlements. ¹⁷I will bring such distress on men that they will walk like blind men because they have sinned against the LORD. Their blood will be poured out like dust and their flesh like dung. ¹⁸Neither their silver nor their gold will be able to deliver them in the day of the LORD's wrath, but the whole land will be devoured by the fire of his jealousy; for he will make an end, yes, a terrible end, of all those who dwell in the land.

²Gather yourselves together, yes, gather together, you nation that has no shame, ²before the appointed time when the day passes as the chaff, before the fierce anger of the LORD comes on you, before the day of the LORD's anger comes on you. ³Seek the LORD, all you humble of the land, who have kept his ordinances. Seek righteousness. Seek humility. It may be that you will be hidden in the day of the LORD's anger. ⁴For Gaza will be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation. They will drive out Ashdod at noonday, and Ekron will be rooted up. ⁵Woe to the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites! The LORD's word is against you, Canaan, the land of the Philistines. I will destroy you until there is no inhabitant. ⁶The sea coast will be pastures, with cottages for shepherds and folds for flocks. ⁷The coast will be for the remnant of the house of Judah. They will find pasture. In the houses of Ashkelon, they will lie down in the evening, for the LORD, their God, ⁱⁱⁱ will visit them and restore them. ⁸I have heard the reproach of Moab and the insults of the children of Ammon, with which they have reproached my people and magnified themselves against their border. ⁹Therefore, as I live, says the LORD of Hosts, the God of Israel, surely Moab will be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah, a possession of nettles and salt pits, and a perpetual desolation. The remnant of my people will plunder them, and the survivors of my nation will inherit them. ¹⁰This they will have for their pride, because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of the LORD of Hosts. ¹¹The LORD will be awesome to them, for he will famish all the gods of the land. Men will worship him,

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ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is "Elohim."

everyone from his place, even all the shores of the nations.¹²You Cushites also, you will be killed by my sword.¹³He will stretch out his hand against the north, destroy Assyria, and will make Nineveh a desolation, as dry as the wilderness.¹⁴Herds will lie down in the middle of her, all kinds of animals. Both the pelican and the porcupine will lodge in its capitals. Their calls will echo through the windows. Desolation will be in the thresholds, for he has laid bare the cedar beams.¹⁵This is the joyous city that lived carelessly, that said in her heart, "I am, and there is no one besides me." How she has become a desolation, a place for animals to lie down in! Everyone who passes by her will hiss and shake their fists.

3Woe to her who is rebellious and polluted, the oppressing city!²She didn't obey the voice. She didn't receive correction. She didn't trust in the LORD. She didn't draw near to her God.³Her princes within her are roaring lions. Her judges are evening wolves. They leave nothing until the next day.⁴Her prophets are arrogant and treacherous people. Her priests have profaned the sanctuary. They have done violence to the law.⁵The LORD, within her, is righteous. He will do no wrong. Every morning he brings his justice to light. He doesn't fail, but the unjust know no shame.⁶I have cut off nations. Their battlements are desolate. I have made their streets waste, so that no one passes by. Their cities are destroyed, so that there is no man, so that there is no inhabitant.⁷I said, "Just fear me. Receive correction," so that her dwelling won't be cut off, according to all that I have appointed concerning her. But they rose early and corrupted all their doings.⁸"Therefore wait for me", says the LORD, "until the day that I rise up to the prey, for my determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms to pour on them my indignation, even all my fierce anger, for all the earth will be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.⁹For then I will purify the lips of the peoples, that they may all call on the LORD's name, to serve him shoulder to shoulder.¹⁰From beyond the rivers of Cush, my worshipers, even the daughter of my dispersed people, will bring my offering.¹¹In that day you will not be disappointed for all your doings in which you have transgressed against me; for then I will take away out from among you your proudly exulting ones, and you will no more be arrogant in my holy mountain.¹²But I will leave among you an afflicted and poor people, and they will take refuge in the LORD's name.¹³The remnant of Israel will not do iniquity nor speak lies, neither will a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth, for they will feed and lie down, and no one will make them afraid."¹⁴Sing, daughter of Zion! Shout, Israel! Be glad and rejoice with all your heart, daughter of Jerusalem.¹⁵The LORD has taken away your judgments. He has thrown out your enemy. The King of Israel, the LORD, is among you. You will not be afraid of evil any more.¹⁶In that

day, it will be said to Jerusalem, "Don't be afraid, Zion. Don't let your hands be weak."¹⁷The LORD, your God, is among you, a mighty one who will save. He will rejoice over you with joy. He will calm you in his love. He will rejoice over you with singing.¹⁸I will remove those who grieve about the appointed feasts from you. They are a burden and a reproach to you.¹⁹Behold,^{iv} at that time I will deal with all those who afflict you; and I will save those who are lame and gather those who were driven away. I will give them praise and honor, whose shame has been in all the earth.²⁰At that time I will bring you in, and at that time I will gather you; for I will give you honor and praise among all the peoples of the earth when I restore your fortunes before your eyes, says the LORD.

^{iv}"Behold", from , " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Haggai

¹In the second year of Darius the king, in the sixth month, in the first day of the month, the LORD's ⁱ word came by Haggai the prophet, to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, saying, ²"This is what the LORD of Hosts says: These people say, 'The time hasn't yet come, the time for the LORD's house to be built.'" ³Then the LORD's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying, ⁴"Is it a time for you yourselves to dwell in your paneled houses, while this house lies waste? ⁵Now therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'Consider your ways. ⁶You have sown much, and bring in little. You eat, but you don't have enough. You drink, but you aren't filled with drink. You clothe yourselves, but no one is warm; and he who earns wages earns wages to put them into a bag with holes in it.' ⁷"This is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'Consider your ways. ⁸Go up to the mountain, bring wood, and build the house. I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified," says the LORD. ⁹"You looked for much, and, behold, ⁱⁱ it came to little; and when you brought it home, I blew it away. Why?" says the LORD of Hosts, "Because of my house that lies waste, while each of you is busy with his own house. ¹⁰Therefore for your sake the heavens withhold the dew, and the earth withholds its fruit. ¹¹I called for a drought on the land, on the mountains, on the grain, on the new wine, on the oil, on that which the ground produces, on men, on livestock, and on all the labor of the hands." ¹²Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed the LORD their God's ⁱⁱⁱ voice, and the words of Haggai the prophet, as the LORD their God, had sent him; and the people feared the LORD. ¹³Then Haggai, the LORD's messenger, spoke the LORD's message to the people, saying, "I am with you," says the LORD. ¹⁴The LORD stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and the spirit of all the remnant of the people; and they came and worked

on the house of the LORD of Hosts, their God, ¹⁵in the twenty-fourth day of the month, in the sixth month, in the second year of Darius the king.

²In the seventh month, in the twenty-first day of the month, the LORD's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying, ²"Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and to the remnant of the people, saying, ³'Who is left among you who saw this house in its former glory? How do you see it now? Isn't it in your eyes as nothing?' ⁴Yet now be strong, Zerubbabel,' says the LORD. 'Be strong, Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest. Be strong, all you people of the land,' says the LORD, 'and work, for I am with you,' says the LORD of Hosts. ⁵This is the word that I covenanted with you when you came out of Egypt, and my Spirit lived among you. 'Don't be afraid.' ⁶For this is what the LORD of Hosts says: 'Yet once more, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, the earth, the sea, and the dry land; ⁷and I will shake all nations. The treasure of all nations will come, and I will fill this house with glory, says the LORD of Hosts. ⁸The silver is mine, and the gold is mine,' says the LORD of Hosts. ⁹'The latter glory of this house will be greater than the former,' says the LORD of Hosts; 'and in this place I will give peace,' says the LORD of Hosts." ¹⁰In the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, the LORD's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying, ¹¹"The LORD of Hosts says: Ask now the priests concerning the law, saying, ¹²'If someone carries holy meat in the fold of his garment, and with his fold touches bread, stew, wine, oil, or any food, will it become holy?'" The priests answered, "No." ¹³Then Haggai said, "If one who is unclean by reason of a dead body touch any of these, will it be unclean?" The priests answered, "It will be unclean." ¹⁴Then Haggai answered, "'So is this people, and so is this nation before me,' says the LORD; 'and so is every work of their hands. That which they offer there is unclean. ¹⁵Now, please consider from this day and backward, before a stone was laid on a stone in the LORD's temple. ¹⁶Through all that time, when one came to a heap of twenty measures, there were only ten. When one came to the wine vat to draw out fifty, there were only

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ⁱⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

twenty. ¹⁷I struck you with blight, mildew, and hail in all the work of your hands; yet you didn't turn to me,' says the LORD. ¹⁸'Consider, please, from this day and backward, from the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, since the day that the foundation of the LORD's temple was laid, consider it. ¹⁹Is the seed yet in the barn? Yes, the vine, the fig tree, the pomegranate, and the olive tree haven't produced. From today I will bless you.'" ²⁰The LORD's word came the second time to Haggai in the twenty-fourth day of the month, saying, ²¹"Speak to Zerubbabel, governor of Judah, saying, 'I will shake the heavens and the earth. ²²I will overthrow the throne of kingdoms. I will destroy the strength of the kingdoms of the nations. I will overthrow the chariots and those who ride in them. The horses and their riders will come down, everyone by the sword of his brother. ²³In that day, says the LORD of Hosts, I will take you, Zerubbabel my servant, the son of Shealtiel,' says the LORD, 'and will make you like a signet ring, for I have chosen you,' says the LORD of Hosts."

Zechariah

¹In the eighth month, in the second year of Darius, the LORD's ⁱ word came to the prophet Zechariah the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo, saying, ²"The LORD was very displeased with your fathers. ³Therefore tell them, the LORD of Hosts says: 'Return to me,' says the LORD of Hosts, 'and I will return to you,' says the LORD of Hosts. ⁴Don't you be like your fathers, to whom the former prophets proclaimed, saying: The LORD of Hosts says, 'Return now from your evil ways and from your evil doings;' but they didn't hear nor listen to me, says the LORD. ⁵Your fathers, where are they? And the prophets, do they live forever? ⁶But my words and my decrees, which I commanded my servants the prophets, didn't they overtake your fathers? ⁷Then they repented and said, 'Just as the LORD of Hosts determined to do to us, according to our ways and according to our practices, so he has dealt with us.' ⁸On the twenty-fourth day of the eleventh month, which is the month Shebat, in the second year of Darius, the LORD's word came to the prophet Zechariah the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo, saying, ⁹"I had a vision in the night, and behold, ¹⁰a man riding on a red horse, and he stood among the myrtle trees that were in a ravine; and behind him there were red, brown, and white horses. ¹¹Then I asked, 'My lord, what are these?'" The angel who talked with me said to me, "I will show you what these are." ¹²The man who stood among the myrtle trees answered, "They are the ones the LORD has sent to go back and forth through the earth." ¹³They reported to the LORD's angel who stood among the myrtle trees, and said, "We have walked back and forth through the earth, and behold, all the earth is at rest and in peace." ¹⁴Then the LORD's angel replied, "O LORD of Hosts, how long will you not have mercy on Jerusalem and on the cities of Judah, against which you have had indignation these seventy years?" ¹⁵The LORD answered the angel who talked with me with kind and comforting words. ¹⁶So the angel who talked with me said to me, "Proclaim, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts says: "I am jealous for Jerusalem and for Zion with a great jealousy. ¹⁷I am very angry with the na-

tions that are at ease; for I was but a little displeased, but they added to the calamity." ¹⁸Therefore the LORD says: "I have returned to Jerusalem with mercy. My house shall be built in it," says the LORD of Hosts, "and a line shall be stretched out over Jerusalem." ¹⁹"Proclaim further, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts says: "My cities will again overflow with prosperity, and the LORD will again comfort Zion, and will again choose Jerusalem."'" ²⁰I lifted up my eyes and saw, and behold, four horns. ²¹I asked the angel who talked with me, "What are these?" He answered me, "These are the horns which have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem." ²²The LORD showed me four craftsmen. ²³Then I asked, "What are these coming to do?" He said, "These are the horns which scattered Judah, so that no man lifted up his head; but these have come to terrify them, to cast down the horns of the nations that lifted up their horn against the land of Judah to scatter it."

²⁴I lifted up my eyes, and saw, and behold, a man with a measuring line in his hand. ²⁵Then I asked, "Where are you going?" He said to me, "To measure Jerusalem, to see what is its width and what is its length." ²⁶Behold, the angel who talked with me went out, and another angel went out to meet him, ²⁷and said to him, "Run, speak to this young man, saying, 'Jerusalem will be inhabited as villages without walls, because of the multitude of men and livestock in it. ²⁸For I,' says the LORD, 'will be to her a wall of fire around it, and I will be the glory in the middle of her. ²⁹Come! Come! Flee from the land of the north,' says the LORD; 'for I have spread you abroad as the four winds of the sky,' says the LORD. ³⁰'Come, Zion! Escape, you who dwell with the daughter of Babylon.' ³¹For the LORD of Hosts says: 'For honor he has sent me to the nations which plundered you; for he who touches you touches the apple of his eye. ³²For, behold, I will shake my hand over them, and they will be a plunder to those who served them; and you will know that the LORD of Hosts has sent me. ³³Sing and rejoice, daughter of Zion! For behold, I come and I will dwell within you,' says the LORD. ³⁴Many nations shall join themselves to the LORD in that day, and shall be my people; and I will dwell among you, and you shall know that the LORD of Hosts has sent me to you. ³⁵The LORD will inherit Judah as his portion

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱ"Behold", from , " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

in the holy land, and will again choose Jerusalem. ¹³Be silent, all flesh, before the LORD; for he has roused himself from his holy habitation!"

³He showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the LORD's angel, and Satan standing at his right hand to be his adversary. ²The LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke you, Satan! Yes, the LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Isn't this a burning stick plucked out of the fire?" ³Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and was standing before the angel. ⁴He answered and spoke to those who stood before him, saying, "Take the filthy garments off him." To him he said, "Behold, I have caused your iniquity to pass from you, and I will clothe you with rich clothing." ⁵I said, "Let them set a clean turban on his head." So they set a clean turban on his head, and clothed him; and the LORD's angel was standing by. ⁶The LORD's angel solemnly assured Joshua, saying, ⁷"The LORD of Hosts says: 'If you will walk in my ways, and if you will follow my instructions, then you also shall judge my house, and shall also keep my courts, and I will give you a place of access among these who stand by.' ⁸Hear now, Joshua the high priest, you and your fellows who sit before you, for they are men who are a sign; for, behold, I will bring out my servant, the Branch. ⁹For, behold, the stone that I have set before Joshua: on one stone are seven eyes; behold, I will engrave its inscription," says the LORD of Hosts, 'and I will remove the iniquity of that land in one day. ¹⁰In that day,' says the LORD of Hosts, 'you will invite every man his neighbor under the vine and under the fig tree.'"

⁴The angel who talked with me came again and wakened me, as a man who is wakened out of his sleep. ²He said to me, "What do you see?" I said, "I have seen, and behold, a lamp stand all of gold, with its bowl on the top of it, and its seven lamps on it; there are seven pipes to each of the lamps which are on the top of it; ³and two olive trees by it, one on the right side of the bowl, and the other on the left side of it." ⁴I answered and spoke to the angel who talked with me, saying, "What are these, my lord?" ⁵Then the angel who talked with me answered me, "Don't you know what these are?" I said, "No, my lord." ⁶Then he answered and spoke to me, saying, "This is the LORD's word to Zerubbabel, saying, 'Not by might, nor by power, but by my Spirit,' says the LORD of Hosts. ⁷Who are you, great mountain? Before Zerubbabel you are a plain; and he will bring out the capstone with shouts of 'Grace, grace, to it!'" ⁸Moreover the LORD's word came to me, saying, ⁹"The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the foundation of this house. His hands shall also finish it; and you will know that the LORD of Hosts has sent me to you. ¹⁰Indeed, who despises the day of small things? For these seven shall rejoice, and shall see the plumb line in the hand

of Zerubbabel. These are the LORD's eyes, which run back and forth through the whole earth." ¹¹Then I asked him, "What are these two olive trees on the right side of the lamp stand and on the left side of it?" ¹²I asked him the second time, "What are these two olive branches, which are beside the two golden spouts that pour the golden oil out of themselves?" ¹³He answered me, "Don't you know what these are?" I said, "No, my lord." ¹⁴Then he said, "These are the two anointed ones who stand by the Lord ⁱⁱⁱ of the whole earth."

⁵Then again I lifted up my eyes and saw, and behold, a flying scroll. ²He said to me, "What do you see?" I answered, "I see a flying scroll; its length is twenty cubits, ^{iv} and its width ten cubits." ³Then he said to me, "This is the curse that goes out over the surface of the whole land, for everyone who steals shall be cut off according to it on the one side; and everyone who swears falsely shall be cut off according to it on the other side. ⁴I will cause it to go out," says the LORD of Hosts, "and it will enter into the house of the thief, and into the house of him who swears falsely by my name; and it will remain in the middle of his house, and will destroy it with its timber and its stones." ⁵Then the angel who talked with me came forward and said to me, "Lift up now your eyes and see what this is that is appearing." ⁶I said, "What is it?" He said, "This is the ephah ^v basket that is appearing." He said moreover, "This is their appearance in all the land— ⁷and behold, a lead cover weighing one talent ^{vi} was lifted up—and there was a woman sitting in the middle of the ephah ^{vii} basket." ⁸He said, "This is Wickedness;" and he threw her down into the middle of the ephah basket; and he threw the lead weight on its mouth. ⁹Then I lifted up my eyes and saw, and behold, there were two women; and the wind was in their wings. Now they had wings like the wings of a stork, and they lifted up the ephah basket between earth and the sky. ¹⁰Then I said to the angel who talked with me, "Where are these carrying the ephah basket?" ¹¹He said to me, "To build her a house in the land of Shinar. When it is prepared, she will be set there in her own place."

⁶Again I lifted up my eyes, and saw, and behold, four chariots came out from between two mountains; and the mountains were mountains of bronze. ²In the first chariot were red horses. In the second chariot were black horses. ³In the third chariot were white horses. In the fourth chariot were dappled horses, all of them powerful. ⁴Then I asked the angel who talked with me, "What are these, my

ⁱⁱⁱThe word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^{iv}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

^vAn ephah is a measure of volume of about 22 liters, 5.8 U. S. gallons, or about 2/3 of a bushel.

^{vi}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

^{vii}1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

lord?" ⁵The angel answered me, "These are the four winds of the sky, which go out from standing before the Lord of all the earth. ⁶The one with the black horses goes out toward the north country; and the white went out after them; and the dappled went out toward the south country." ⁷The strong went out, and sought to go that they might walk back and forth through the earth. He said, "Go around and through the earth!" So they walked back and forth through the earth. ⁸Then he called to me, and spoke to me, saying, "Behold, those who go toward the north country have quieted my spirit in the north country." ⁹The LORD's word came to me, saying, ¹⁰"Take of them of the captivity, even of Heldai, of Tobijah, and of Jedaiah; and come the same day, and go into the house of Josiah the son of Zephaniah, where they have come from Babylon. ¹¹Yes, take silver and gold, and make crowns, and set them on the head of Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest; ¹²and speak to him, saying, 'The LORD of Hosts says, "Behold, the man whose name is the Branch! He will grow up out of his place; and he will build the LORD's temple. ¹³He will build the LORD's temple. He will bear the glory, and will sit and rule on his throne. He will be a priest on his throne. The counsel of peace will be between them both. ¹⁴The crowns shall be to Helem, to Tobijah, to Jedaiah, and to Hen the son of Zephaniah, for a memorial in the LORD's temple. ¹⁵Those who are far off shall come and build in the LORD's temple; and you shall know that the LORD of Hosts has sent me to you. This will happen, if you will diligently obey the LORD your God's voice.'" ^{viii}

⁷In the fourth year of King Darius, the LORD's word came to Zechariah in the fourth day of the ninth month, the month of Chislev. ²The people of Bethel sent Sharezer and Regem Melech and their men to entreat the LORD's favor, ³and to speak to the priests of the house of the LORD of Hosts and to the prophets, saying, "Should I weep in the fifth month, separating myself, as I have done these so many years?" ⁴Then the word of the LORD of Hosts came to me, saying, ⁵"Speak to all the people of the land and to the priests, saying, 'When you fasted and mourned in the fifth and in the seventh month for these seventy years, did you at all fast to me, really to me? ⁶When you eat and when you drink, don't you eat for yourselves and drink for yourselves? ⁷Aren't these the words which the LORD proclaimed by the former prophets when Jerusalem was inhabited and in prosperity, and its cities around her, and the South and the lowland were inhabited?" ⁸The LORD's word came to Zechariah, saying, ⁹"Thus has the LORD of Hosts spoken, saying, 'Execute true judgment, and show kindness and compassion every man to his brother. ¹⁰Don't oppress the widow, the fatherless, the foreigner, nor the poor; and let none of you devise

evil against his brother in your heart.' ¹¹But they refused to listen, and turned their backs, and stopped their ears, that they might not hear. ¹²Yes, they made their hearts as hard as flint, lest they might hear the law and the words which the LORD of Hosts had sent by his Spirit by the former prophets. Therefore great wrath came from the LORD of Hosts. ¹³It has come to pass that, as he called and they refused to listen, so they will call and I will not listen," said the LORD of Hosts; ¹⁴"but I will scatter them with a whirlwind among all the nations which they have not known. Thus the land was desolate after them, so that no man passed through nor returned; for they made the pleasant land desolate."

⁸The word of the LORD of Hosts came to me. ²The LORD of Hosts says: "I am jealous for Zion with great jealousy, and I am jealous for her with great wrath." ³The LORD says: "I have returned to Zion, and will dwell in the middle of Jerusalem. Jerusalem shall be called 'The City of Truth;' and the mountain of the LORD of Hosts, 'The Holy Mountain.'" ⁴The LORD of Hosts says: "Old men and old women will again dwell in the streets of Jerusalem, every man with his staff in his hand because of their old age. ⁵The streets of the city will be full of boys and girls playing in its streets." ⁶The LORD of Hosts says: "If it is marvelous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in those days, should it also be marvelous in my eyes?" says the LORD of Hosts. ⁷The LORD of Hosts says: "Behold, I will save my people from the east country and from the west country. ⁸I will bring them, and they will dwell within Jerusalem. They will be my people, and I will be their God, in truth and in righteousness." ⁹The LORD of Hosts says: "Let your hands be strong, you who hear in these days these words from the mouth of the prophets who were in the day that the foundation of the house of the LORD of Hosts was laid, even the temple, that it might be built. ¹⁰For before those days there was no wages for man nor any wages for an animal, neither was there any peace to him who went out or came in, because of the adversary. For I set all men everyone against his neighbor. ¹¹But now I will not be to the remnant of this people as in the former days," says the LORD of Hosts. ¹²"For the seed of peace and the vine will yield its fruit, and the ground will give its increase, and the heavens will give their dew. I will cause the remnant of this people to inherit all these things. ¹³It shall come to pass that, as you were a curse among the nations, house of Judah and house of Israel, so I will save you, and you shall be a blessing. Don't be afraid. Let your hands be strong." ¹⁴For the LORD of Hosts says: "As I thought to do evil to you when your fathers provoked me to wrath," says the LORD of Hosts, "and I didn't repent, ¹⁵so again I have thought in these days to do good to Jerusalem and to the house of Judah. Don't be afraid. ¹⁶These are the things that you shall do:

^{viii}The Hebrew word rendered "God" is " (Elohim).

speaking every man the truth with his neighbor. Execute the judgment of truth and peace in your gates,¹⁷ and let none of you devise evil in your hearts against his neighbor, and love no false oath; for all these are things that I hate," says the LORD.¹⁸ The word of the LORD of Hosts came to me.¹⁹ The LORD of Hosts says: "The fasts of the fourth, fifth, seventh, and tenth months shall be for the house of Judah joy, gladness, and cheerful feasts. Therefore love truth and peace."²⁰ The LORD of Hosts says: "Many peoples and the inhabitants of many cities will yet come.²¹ The inhabitants of one will go to another, saying, 'Let's go speedily to entreat the favor of the LORD, and to seek the LORD of Hosts. I will go also.'²² Yes, many peoples and strong nations will come to seek the LORD of Hosts in Jerusalem and to entreat the favor of the LORD."²³ The LORD of Hosts says: "In those days, ten men out of all the languages of the nations will take hold of the skirt of him who is a Jew, saying, 'We will go with you, for we have heard that God is with you.'"

9A revelation. The LORD's word is against the land of Hadrach, and will rest upon Damascus—for the eye of man and of all the tribes of Israel is toward the LORD—² and Hamath, also, which borders on it, Tyre and Sidon, because they are very wise.³ Tyre built herself a stronghold, and heaped up silver like the dust, and fine gold like the mire of the streets.⁴ Behold, the Lord will dispossess her, and he will strike her power in the sea; and she will be devoured with fire.⁵ Ashkelon will see it, and fear; Gaza also, and will writhe in agony; as will Ekron, for her expectation will be disappointed; and the king will perish from Gaza, and Ashkelon will not be inhabited.⁶ Foreigners will dwell in Ashdod, and I will cut off the pride of the Philistines.⁷ I will take away his blood out of his mouth, and his abominations from between his teeth; and he also will be a remnant for our God; and he will be as a chieftain in Judah, and Ekron as a Jebusite.⁸ I will encamp around my house against the army, that no one pass through or return; and no oppressor will pass through them any more: for now I have seen with my eyes.⁹ Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion! Shout, daughter of Jerusalem! Behold, your King comes to you! He is righteous, and having salvation; lowly, and riding on a donkey, even on a colt, the foal of a donkey.¹⁰ I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim and the horse from Jerusalem. The battle bow will be cut off; and he will speak peace to the nations. His dominion will be from sea to sea, and from the River to the ends of the earth.¹¹ As for you also, because of the blood of your covenant, I have set free your prisoners from the pit in which is no water.¹² Turn to the stronghold, you prisoners of hope! Even today I declare that I will restore double to you.¹³ For indeed I bend Judah as a bow for me. I have loaded the bow with Ephraim. I will stir up your sons, Zion, against your sons, Greece, and will make you like the sword of a mighty

man.¹⁴ The LORD will be seen over them. His arrow will flash like lightning. The Lord GOD will blow the shofar, and will go with whirlwinds of the south.¹⁵ The LORD of Hosts will defend them. They will destroy and overcome with sling stones. They will drink, and roar as through wine. They will be filled like bowls, like the corners of the altar.¹⁶ The LORD their God will save them in that day as the flock of his people; for they are like the jewels of a crown, lifted on high over his land.¹⁷ For how great is his goodness, and how great is his beauty! Grain will make the young men flourish, and new wine the virgins.

10Ask of the LORD rain in the spring time, The LORD who makes storm clouds, and he gives rain showers to everyone for the plants in the field.² For the teraphim^{ix} have spoken vanity, and the diviners have seen a lie; and they have told false dreams. They comfort in vain. Therefore they go their way like sheep. They are oppressed, because there is no shepherd.³ My anger is kindled against the shepherds, and I will punish the male goats, for the LORD of Hosts has visited his flock, the house of Judah, and will make them as his majestic horse in the battle.⁴ From him will come the cornerstone, from him the tent peg, from him the battle bow, from him every ruler together.⁵ They will be as mighty men, treading down muddy streets in the battle. They will fight, because the LORD is with them. The riders on horses will be confounded.⁶ "I will strengthen the house of Judah, and I will save the house of Joseph. I will bring them back, for I have mercy on them. They will be as though I had not cast them off, for I am the LORD their God, and I will hear them.⁷ Ephraim will be like a mighty man, and their heart will rejoice as through wine. Yes, their children will see it and rejoice. Their heart will be glad in the LORD.⁸ I will signal for them and gather them, for I have redeemed them. They will increase as they were before.⁹ I will sow them among the peoples. They will remember me in far countries. They will live with their children and will return.¹⁰ I will bring them again also out of the land of Egypt, and gather them out of Assyria. I will bring them into the land of Gilead and Lebanon; and there won't be room enough for them.¹¹ He will pass through the sea of affliction, and will strike the waves in the sea, and all the depths of the Nile will dry up; and the pride of Assyria will be brought down, and the scepter of Egypt will depart.¹² I will strengthen them in the LORD. They will walk up and down in his name," says the LORD.

11Open your doors, Lebanon, that the fire may devour your cedars.² Wail, cypress tree, for the cedar has fallen, because the stately ones are destroyed. Wail, you oaks of Bashan, for the strong forest has come down.³ A voice of

^{ix}teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

the wailing of the shepherds! For their glory is destroyed—a voice of the roaring of young lions! For the pride of the Jordan is ruined. ⁴The LORD my God says: “Feed the flock of slaughter. ⁵Their buyers slaughter them and go unpunished. Those who sell them say, ‘Blessed be the LORD, for I am rich;’ and their own shepherds don’t pity them. ⁶For I will no more pity the inhabitants of the land,” says the LORD; “but, behold, I will deliver every one of the men into his neighbor’s hand and into the hand of his king. They will strike the land, and out of their hand I will not deliver them.” ⁷So I fed the flock to be slaughtered, especially the oppressed of the flock. I took for myself two staffs. The one I called “Favor” and the other I called “Union”, and I fed the flock. ⁸I cut off the three shepherds in one month; for my soul was weary of them, and their soul also loathed me. ⁹Then I said, “I will not feed you. That which dies, let it die; and that which is to be cut off, let it be cut off; and let those who are left eat each other’s flesh.” ¹⁰I took my staff Favor and cut it apart, that I might break my covenant that I had made with all the peoples. ¹¹It was broken in that day; and thus the poor of the flock that listened to me knew that it was the LORD’s word. ¹²I said to them, “If you think it best, give me my wages; and if not, keep them.” So they weighed for my wages thirty pieces of silver. ¹³The LORD said to me, “Throw it to the potter—the handsome price that I was valued at by them!” I took the thirty pieces of silver and threw them to the potter in the LORD’s house. ¹⁴Then I cut apart my other staff, Union, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel. ¹⁵The LORD said to me, “Take for yourself yet again the equipment of a foolish shepherd. ¹⁶For, behold, I will raise up a shepherd in the land who will not visit those who are cut off, neither will seek those who are scattered, nor heal that which is broken, nor feed that which is sound; but he will eat the meat of the fat sheep, and will tear their hoofs in pieces. ¹⁷Woe to the worthless shepherd who leaves the flock! The sword will strike his arm and his right eye. His arm will be completely withered, and his right eye will be totally blinded!”

12A revelation of the LORD’s word concerning Israel: The LORD, who stretches out the heavens and lays the foundation of the earth, and forms the spirit of man within him says: ²“Behold, I will make Jerusalem a cup of reeling to all the surrounding peoples, and it will also be on Judah in the siege against Jerusalem. ³It will happen in that day that I will make Jerusalem a burdensome stone for all the peoples. All who burden themselves with it will be severely wounded, and all the nations of the earth will be gathered together against it. ⁴In that day,” says the LORD, “I will strike every horse with terror and his rider with madness. I will open my eyes on the house of Judah, and will strike every horse of the peoples with blindness.

⁵The chieftains of Judah will say in their heart, ‘The inhabitants of Jerusalem are my strength in the LORD of Hosts their God.’ ⁶In that day I will make the chieftains of Judah like a pan of fire among wood, and like a flaming torch among sheaves. They will devour all the surrounding peoples on the right hand and on the left; and Jerusalem will yet again dwell in their own place, even in Jerusalem. ⁷The LORD also will save the tents of Judah first, that the glory of David’s house and the glory of the inhabitants of Jerusalem not be magnified above Judah. ⁸In that day the LORD will defend the inhabitants of Jerusalem. He who is feeble among them at that day will be like David, and David’s house will be like God, like the LORD’s angel before them. ⁹It will happen in that day, that I will seek to destroy all the nations that come against Jerusalem. ¹⁰I will pour on David’s house and on the inhabitants of Jerusalem the spirit of grace and of supplication. They will look to me ^x whom they have pierced; and they shall mourn for him as one mourns for his only son, and will grieve bitterly for him as one grieves for his firstborn. ¹¹In that day there will be a great mourning in Jerusalem, like the mourning of Hadadrimmon in the valley of Megiddo. ¹²The land will mourn, every family apart; the family of David’s house apart, and their wives apart; the family of the house of Nathan apart, and their wives apart; ¹³the family of the house of Levi apart, and their wives apart; the family of the Shimeites apart, and their wives apart; ¹⁴all the families who remain, every family apart, and their wives apart.

13“In that day there will be a fountain opened to David’s house and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, for sin and for uncleanness. ²It will come to pass in that day, says the LORD of Hosts, that I will cut off the names of the idols out of the land, and they will be remembered no more. I will also cause the prophets and the spirit of impurity to pass out of the land. ³It will happen that when anyone still prophesies, then his father and his mother who bore him will tell him, ‘You must die, because you speak lies in the LORD’s name;’ and his father and his mother who bore him will stab him when he prophesies. ⁴It will happen in that day that the prophets will each be ashamed of his vision when he prophesies; they won’t wear a hairy mantle to deceive, ⁵but he will say, ‘I am no prophet, I am a tiller of the ground; for I have been made a bondservant from my youth.’ ⁶One will say to him, ‘What are these wounds between your arms?’ Then he will answer, ‘Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends.’ ⁷“Awake, sword, against my shepherd, and against the man who is close to me,” says the LORD of Hosts. “Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered; and I will turn my

^xAfter “me”, the Hebrew has the two letters “Aleph Tav” (the first and last letters of the Hebrew alphabet), not as a word, but as a grammatical marker.

hand against the little ones. ⁸It shall happen that in all the land,” says the LORD, “two parts in it will be cut off and die; but the third will be left in it. ⁹I will bring the third part into the fire, and will refine them as silver is refined, and will test them like gold is tested. They will call on my name, and I will hear them. I will say, ‘It is my people;’ and they will say, ‘The LORD is my God.’”

¹⁴Behold, a day of the LORD comes, when your plunder will be divided within you. ²For I will gather all nations against Jerusalem to battle; and the city will be taken, the houses rifled, and the women ravished. Half of the city will go out into captivity, and the rest of the people will not be cut off from the city. ³Then the LORD will go out and fight against those nations, as when he fought in the day of battle. ⁴His feet will stand in that day on the Mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east; and the Mount of Olives will be split in two from east to west, making a very great valley. Half of the mountain will move toward the north, and half of it toward the south. ⁵You shall flee by the valley of my mountains, for the valley of the mountains shall reach to Azel. Yes, you shall flee, just like you fled from before the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah. The LORD my God will come, and all the holy ones with you. ^{xi} ⁶It will happen in that day that there will not be light, cold, or frost. ⁷It will be a unique day which is known to the LORD—not day, and not night; but it will come to pass that at evening time there will be light. ⁸It will happen in that day that living waters will go out from Jerusalem, half of them toward the eastern sea, and half of them toward the western sea. It will be so in summer and in winter. ⁹The LORD will be King over all the earth. In that day the LORD will be one, and his name one. ¹⁰All the land will be made like the Arabah, from Geba to Rimmon south of Jerusalem; and she will be lifted up and will dwell in her place, from Benjamin’s gate to the place of the first gate, to the corner gate, and from the tower of Hananel to the king’s wine presses. ¹¹Men will dwell therein, and there will be no more curse; but Jerusalem will dwell safely. ¹²This will be the plague with which the LORD will strike all the peoples who have fought against Jerusalem: their flesh will consume away while they stand on their feet, and their eyes will consume away in their sockets, and their tongue will consume away in their mouth. ¹³It will happen in that day that a great panic from the LORD will be among them; and they will each seize the hand of his neighbor, and his hand will rise up against the hand of his neighbor. ¹⁴Judah also will fight at Jerusalem; and the wealth of all the surrounding nations will be gathered together: gold, silver, and clothing, in great abundance. ¹⁵A plague like this will fall on the horse, on the mule, on the camel, on the donkey, and on all the animals that will be in those

camps. ¹⁶It will happen that everyone who is left of all the nations that came against Jerusalem will go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of Hosts, and to keep the feast of booths. ¹⁷It will be that whoever of all the families of the earth doesn’t go up to Jerusalem to worship the King, the LORD of Hosts, on them there will be no rain. ¹⁸If the family of Egypt doesn’t go up and doesn’t come, neither will it rain on them. This will be the plague with which the LORD will strike the nations that don’t go up to keep the feast of booths. ¹⁹This will be the punishment of Egypt and the punishment of all the nations that don’t go up to keep the feast of booths. ²⁰In that day there will be inscribed on the bells of the horses, “HOLY TO THE LORD”; and the pots in the LORD’s house will be like the bowls before the altar. ²¹Yes, every pot in Jerusalem and in Judah will be holy to the LORD of Hosts; and all those who sacrifice will come and take of them, and cook in them. In that day there will no longer be a Canaanite ^{xii} in the house of the LORD of Hosts.

^{xi}Septuagint reads “him” instead of “you”.

^{xii}or, merchant

Malachi

¹A revelation, the LORD's ⁱ word to Israel by Malachi. ²"I have loved you," says the LORD. Yet you say, "How have you loved us?" "Wasn't Esau Jacob's brother?" says the LORD, "Yet I loved Jacob; ³but Esau I hated, and made his mountains a desolation, and gave his heritage to the jackals of the wilderness." ⁴Whereas Edom says, "We are beaten down, but we will return and build the waste places," the LORD of Hosts says, "They shall build, but I will throw down; and men will call them 'The Wicked Land,' even the people against whom the LORD shows wrath forever." ⁵Your eyes will see, and you will say, "The LORD is great—even beyond the border of Israel!" ⁶"A son honors his father, and a servant his master. If I am a father, then where is my honor? And if I am a master, where is the respect due me?" says the LORD of Hosts to you priests who despise my name. "You say, 'How have we despised your name?' ⁷You offer polluted bread on my altar. You say, 'How have we polluted you?' In that you say, 'The LORD's table is contemptible.' ⁸When you offer the blind for sacrifice, isn't that evil? And when you offer the lame and sick, isn't that evil? Present it now to your governor! Will he be pleased with you? Or will he accept your person?" says the LORD of Hosts. ⁹"Now, please entreat the favor of God, ⁱⁱ that he may be gracious to us. With this, will he accept any of you?" says the LORD of Hosts. ¹⁰"Oh that there were one among you who would shut the doors, that you might not kindle fire on my altar in vain! I have no pleasure in you," says the LORD of Hosts, "neither will I accept an offering at your hand. ¹¹For from the rising of the sun even to its going down, my name is great among the nations, and in every place incense will be offered to my name, and a pure offering; for my name is great among the nations," says the LORD of Hosts. ¹²"But you profane it when you say, 'The LORD's table is polluted, and its fruit, even its food, is contemptible.' ¹³You say also, 'Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ what a weariness it is!' And you have sniffed at it", says the LORD of Hosts; "and you have brought that which was taken by violence,

the lame, and the sick; thus you bring the offering. Should I accept this at your hand?" says the LORD. ¹⁴"But the deceiver is cursed who has in his flock a male, and vows and sacrifices to the Lord ^{iv} a defective thing; for I am a great King," says the LORD of Hosts, "and my name is awesome among the nations."

²"Now, you priests, this commandment is for you. ²If you will not listen, and if you will not take it to heart, to give glory to my name," says the LORD of Hosts, "then I will send the curse on you, and I will curse your blessings. Indeed, I have cursed them already, because you do not take it to heart. ³Behold, I will rebuke your offspring, ^v and will spread dung on your faces, even the dung of your feasts; and you will be taken away with it. ⁴You will know that I have sent this commandment to you, that my covenant may be with Levi," says the LORD of Hosts. ⁵"My covenant was with him of life and peace; and I gave them to him that he might be reverent toward me; and he was reverent toward me, and stood in awe of my name. ⁶The law of truth was in his mouth, and unrighteousness was not found in his lips. He walked with me in peace and uprightness, and turned many away from iniquity. ⁷For the priest's lips should keep knowledge, and they should seek the law at his mouth; for he is the messenger of the LORD of Hosts. ⁸But you have turned away from the path. You have caused many to stumble in the law. You have corrupted the covenant of Levi," says the LORD of Hosts. ⁹"Therefore I have also made you contemptible and wicked before all the people, according to the way you have not kept my ways, but have had respect for persons in the law. ¹⁰Don't we all have one father? Hasn't one God created us? Why do we deal treacherously every man against his brother, profaning the covenant of our fathers? ¹¹Judah has dealt treacherously, and an abomination is committed in Israel and in Jerusalem; for Judah has profaned the holiness of the LORD which he loves, and has married the daughter of a foreign god. ¹²The LORD will cut off the man who does this, him who wakes and him who answers, out of the tents of Jacob and him who offers an offering to

ⁱWhen rendered in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS, "LORD" or "GOD" is the translation of God's Proper Name.

ⁱⁱThe Hebrew word rendered "God" is " " (Elohim).

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}The word translated "Lord" (mixed case) is "Adonai."

^vor, seed

the LORD of Hosts. ¹³“This again you do: you cover the LORD’s altar with tears, with weeping, and with sighing, because he doesn’t regard the offering any more, neither receives it with good will at your hand. ¹⁴Yet you say, ‘Why?’ Because the LORD has been witness between you and the wife of your youth, against whom you have dealt treacherously, though she is your companion and the wife of your covenant. ¹⁵Did he not make you one, although he had the residue of the Spirit? Why one? He sought godly offspring. Therefore take heed to your spirit, and let no one deal treacherously against the wife of his youth. ¹⁶One who hates and divorces”, says the LORD, the God of Israel, “covers his garment with violence!” says the LORD of Hosts. “Therefore pay attention to your spirit, that you don’t be unfaithful. ¹⁷You have wearied the LORD with your words. Yet you say, ‘How have we wearied him?’ In that you say, ‘Everyone who does evil is good in the LORD’s sight, and he delights in them;’ or ‘Where is the God of justice?’

³“Behold, I send my messenger, and he will prepare the way before me! The Lord, whom you seek, will suddenly come to his temple. Behold, the messenger of the covenant, whom you desire, is coming!” says the LORD of Hosts. ²“But who can endure the day of his coming? And who will stand when he appears? For he is like a refiner’s fire, and like launderers’ soap; ³and he will sit as a refiner and purifier of silver, and he will purify the sons of Levi, and refine them as gold and silver; and they shall offer to the LORD offerings in righteousness. ⁴Then the offering of Judah and Jerusalem will be pleasant to the LORD as in the days of old and as in ancient years. ⁵I will come near to you to judgment. I will be a swift witness against the sorcerers, against the adulterers, against the perjurers, and against those who oppress the hireling in his wages, the widow, and the fatherless, and who deprive the foreigner of justice, and don’t fear me,” says the LORD of Hosts. ⁶“For I, the LORD, don’t change; therefore you, sons of Jacob, are not consumed. ⁷From the days of your fathers you have turned away from my ordinances and have not kept them. Return to me, and I will return to you,” says the LORD of Hosts. “But you say, ‘How shall we return?’ ⁸Will a man rob God? Yet you rob me! But you say, ‘How have we robbed you?’ In tithes and offerings. ⁹You are cursed with the curse; for you rob me, even this whole nation. ¹⁰Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, that there may be food in my house, and test me now in this,” says the LORD of Hosts, “if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there will not be enough room for. ¹¹I will rebuke the devourer for your sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits of your ground; neither shall your vine cast its fruit before its time in the field,” says the LORD of Hosts. ¹²“All nations shall call you blessed, for you will be a delightful land,” says the

LORD of Hosts. ¹³“Your words have been harsh against me,” says the LORD. “Yet you say, ‘What have we spoken against you?’ ¹⁴You have said, ‘It is vain to serve God,’ and ‘What profit is it that we have followed his instructions and that we have walked mournfully before the LORD of Hosts? ¹⁵Now we call the proud happy; yes, those who work wickedness are built up; yes, they tempt God, and escape.’ ¹⁶Then those who feared the LORD spoke one with another; and the LORD listened and heard, and a book of memory was written before him for those who feared the LORD and who honored his name. ¹⁷They shall be mine,” says the LORD of Hosts, “my own possession in the day that I make. I will spare them, as a man spares his own son who serves him. ¹⁸Then you shall return and discern between the righteous and the wicked, between him who serves God and him who doesn’t serve him.

⁴“For behold, the day comes, burning like a furnace, when all the proud and all who work wickedness will be stubble. The day that comes will burn them up,” says the LORD of Hosts, “so that it will leave them neither root nor branch. ²But to you who fear my name shall the sun of righteousness arise with healing in its wings. You will go out and leap like calves of the stall. ³You shall tread down the wicked; for they will be ashes under the soles of your feet in the day that I make,” says the LORD of Hosts. ⁴“Remember the Torah of Moses my servant, which I commanded to him in Horeb for all Israel, even statutes and ordinances. ⁵Behold, I will send you Elijah the prophet before the great and terrible day of the LORD comes. ⁶He will turn the hearts of the fathers to the children and the hearts of the children to their fathers, lest I come and strike the earth with a curse.”

Part II

The New Testament

Matthew

¹A record of the genealogy of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ the son of David, the son of Abraham. ²Abraham became the father of Isaac. Isaac became the father of Jacob. Jacob became the father of Judah and his brothers. ³Judah became the father of Perez and Zerah by Tamar. Perez became the father of Hezron. Hezron became the father of Ram. ⁴Ram became the father of Amminadab. Amminadab became the father of Nahshon. Nahshon became the father of Salmon. ⁵Salmon became the father of Boaz by Rahab. Boaz became the father of Obed by Ruth. Obed became the father of Jesse. ⁶Jesse became the father of King David. David the king ⁱⁱ became the father of Solomon by her who had been Uriah's wife. ⁷Solomon became the father of Rehoboam. Rehoboam became the father of Abijah. Abijah became the father of Asa. ⁸Asa became the father of Jehoshaphat. Jehoshaphat became the father of Joram. Joram became the father of Uzziah. ⁹Uzziah became the father of Jotham. Jotham became the father of Ahaz. Ahaz became the father of Hezekiah. ¹⁰Hezekiah became the father of Manasseh. Manasseh became the father of Amon. Amon became the father of Josiah. ¹¹Josiah became the father of Jechoniah and his brothers at the time of the exile to Babylon. ¹²After the exile to Babylon, Jechoniah became the father of Shealtiel. Shealtiel became the father of Zerubbabel. ¹³Zerubbabel became the father of Abiud. Abiud became the father of Eliakim. Eliakim became the father of Azor. ¹⁴Azor became the father of Zadok. Zadok became the father of Achim. Achim became the father of Eliud. ¹⁵Eliud became the father of Eleazar. Eleazar became the father of Matthan. Matthan became the father of Jacob. ¹⁶Jacob became the father of Joseph, the husband of Miriam, from whom was born Yeshua, ⁱⁱⁱ who is called Messiah. ¹⁷So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; from David to the exile to Babylon fourteen generations; and from the carrying away to Babylon to the Messiah, fourteen generations. ¹⁸Now the birth of Yeshua the Messiah was like this: After his mother, Miriam, was engaged to Joseph, before they came together, she was found pregnant by the Holy Spirit.

ⁱMessiah (Hebrew) and Christ (Greek) both mean "Anointed One"

ⁱⁱNU omits "the king".

ⁱⁱⁱ"Yeshua" means "Salvation".

¹⁹Joseph, her husband, being a righteous man, and not willing to make her a public example, intended to put her away secretly. ²⁰But when he thought about these things, behold, ^{iv} an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying, "Joseph, son of David, don't be afraid to take to yourself Miriam as your wife, for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Spirit. ²¹She shall give birth to a son. You shall name him Yeshua, ^v for it is he who shall save his people from their sins." ²²Now all this has happened that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the Lord through the prophet, saying, ²³"Behold, the virgin shall be with child, and shall give birth to a son. They shall call his name Immanuel," which is, being interpreted, "God with us." ²⁴Joseph arose from his sleep, and did as the angel of the Lord commanded him, and took his wife to himself; ²⁵and didn't know her sexually until she had given birth to her firstborn son. He named him Yeshua.

²Now when Yeshua was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of King Herod, behold, wise men ^{vi} from the east came to Jerusalem, saying, ²"Where is he who is born King of the Jews? For we saw his star in the east, and have come to worship him." ³When King Herod heard it, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him. ⁴Gathering together all the chief priests and scribes of the people, he asked them where the Messiah would be born. ⁵They said to him, "In Bethlehem of Judea, for this is written through the prophet, ⁶'You Bethlehem, land of Judah, are in no way least among the princes of Judah; for out of you shall come a governor who shall shepherd my people, Israel.'" ⁷Then Herod secretly called the wise men, and learned from them exactly what time the star appeared. ⁸He sent them to Bethlehem, and said, "Go and search diligently for the young child. When you have found him, bring me word, so that I also may come and worship him." ⁹They, having heard the king, went their way; and behold, the star, which they saw in the east, went before them

^{iv}"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^v"Yeshua" means "Salvation".

^{vi}The word for "wise men" (magi) can also mean teachers, scientists, physicians, astrologers, seers, interpreters of dreams, or sorcerers.

until it came and stood over where the young child was.¹⁰ When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceedingly great joy.¹¹ They came into the house and saw the young child with Miriam, his mother, and they fell down and worshiped him. Opening their treasures, they offered to him gifts: gold, frankincense, and myrrh.¹² Being warned in a dream not to return to Herod, they went back to their own country another way.¹³ Now when they had departed, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream, saying, "Arise and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and stay there until I tell you, for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him."¹⁴ He arose and took the young child and his mother by night and departed into Egypt,¹⁵ and was there until the death of Herod, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the Lord through the prophet, saying, "Out of Egypt I called my son."¹⁶ Then Herod, when he saw that he was mocked by the wise men, was exceedingly angry, and sent out and killed all the male children who were in Bethlehem and in all the surrounding countryside, from two years old and under, according to the exact time which he had learned from the wise men.¹⁷ Then that which was spoken by Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled, saying,¹⁸ "A voice was heard in Ramah, lamentation, weeping and great mourning, Rachel weeping for her children; she wouldn't be comforted, because they are no more."¹⁹ But when Herod was dead, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared in a dream to Joseph in Egypt, saying,²⁰ "Arise and take the young child and his mother, and go into Eretz-Israel, for those who sought the young child's life are dead."²¹ He arose and took the young child and his mother, and came into Eretz-Israel.²² But when he heard that Archelaus was reigning over Judea in the place of his father, Herod, he was afraid to go there. Being warned in a dream, he withdrew into the region of Galilee,²³ and came and lived in a city called Nazareth; that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through the prophets that he will be called a Nazarene.

3In those days, Yochanan the Immerser came, proclaiming in the wilderness of Judea, saying,² "Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is at hand!"³ For this is he who was spoken of by Isaiah the prophet, saying, "The voice of one crying in the wilderness, make the way of the Lord ready! Make his paths straight!"⁴ Now Yochanan himself wore clothing made of camel's hair with a leather belt around his waist. His food was locusts and wild honey.⁵ Then people from Jerusalem, all of Judea, and all the region around the Jordan went out to him.⁶ They were immersed by him in the Jordan, confessing their sins.⁷ But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming for his immersion, he said to them, "You offspring of vipers, who warned you to flee from the wrath to come?"⁸ Therefore produce fruit worthy of repentance!⁹ Don't think to your-

selves, 'We have Abraham for our father,' for I tell you that God is able to raise up children to Abraham from these stones.¹⁰ Even now the ax lies at the root of the trees. Therefore every tree that doesn't produce good fruit is cut down, and cast into the fire.¹¹ "I indeed immerse you in water for repentance, but he who comes after me is mightier than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will immerse you in the Holy Spirit."^{vii} ¹²His winnowing fork is in his hand, and he will thoroughly cleanse his threshing floor. He will gather his wheat into the barn, but the chaff he will burn up with unquenchable fire."¹³ Then Yeshua came from Galilee to the Jordan^{viii} to Yochanan, to be immersed by him.¹⁴ But Yochanan would have hindered him, saying, "I need to be immersed by you, and you come to me?"¹⁵ But Yeshua, answering, said to him, "Allow it now, for this is the fitting way for us to fulfill all righteousness." Then he allowed him.¹⁶ Yeshua, when he was immersed, went up directly from the water: and behold, the heavens were opened to him. He saw the Spirit of God descending as a dove, and coming on him.¹⁷ Behold, a voice out of the heavens said, "This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased."

4Then Yeshua was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.² When he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was hungry afterward.³ The tempter came and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, command that these stones become bread."⁴ But he answered, "It is written, 'Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds out of God's mouth.'"⁵ Then the devil took him into the holy city. He set him on the pinnacle of the temple,⁶ and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down, for it is written, 'He will command his angels concerning you,' and, 'On their hands they will bear you up, so that you don't dash your foot against a stone.'"⁷ Yeshua said to him, "Again, it is written, 'You shall not test the Lord, your God.'"⁸ Again, the devil took him to an exceedingly high mountain, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory.⁹ He said to him, "I will give you all of these things, if you will fall down and worship me."¹⁰ Then Yeshua said to him, "Get behind me,"^{ix} Satan! For it is written, 'You shall worship the Lord your God, and you shall serve him only.'"¹¹ Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and served him.¹² Now when Yeshua heard that Yochanan was delivered up, he withdrew into Galilee.¹³ Leaving Nazareth, he came and lived in Capernaum, which is by the sea, in the region of Zebulun and Naphtali,¹⁴ that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through Isaiah the prophet, saying,¹⁵ "The land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali, toward the sea, beyond the

^{vii}TR and NU add "and with fire"

^{viii}i.e., the Jordan River

^{ix}TR and NU read "Go away" instead of "Get behind me"

Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles, ¹⁶the people who sat in darkness saw a great light; to those who sat in the region and shadow of death, to them light has dawned.” ¹⁷From that time, Yeshua began to proclaim, and to say, “Repent! For the Kingdom of Heaven is at hand.” ¹⁸Walking by the sea of Galilee, he ^xsaw two brothers: Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew, his brother, casting a net into the sea; for they were fishermen. ¹⁹He said to them, “Come after me, and I will make you fishers for men.” ²⁰They immediately left their nets and followed him. ²¹Going on from there, he saw two other brothers, Jacob the son of Zebedee, and Yochanan his brother, in the boat with Zebedee their father, mending their nets. He called them. ²²They immediately left the boat and their father, and followed him. ²³Yeshua went about in all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, proclaiming the Good News of the Kingdom, and healing every disease and every sickness among the people. ²⁴The report about him went out into all Syria. They brought to him all who were sick, afflicted with various diseases and torments, possessed with demons, epileptics, and paralytics; and he healed them. ²⁵Great multitudes from Galilee, Decapolis, Jerusalem, Judea, and from beyond the Jordan followed him.

⁵Seeing the multitudes, he went up onto the mountain. When he had sat down, his disciples came to him. ²He opened his mouth and taught them, saying, ^{3a} Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven. ⁴Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted. ⁵Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth. ^{xi} ⁶Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be filled. ⁷Blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy. ⁸Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God. ⁹Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called children of God. ¹⁰Blessed are those who have been persecuted for righteousness’ sake, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven. ^{11a} Blessed are you when people reproach you, persecute you, and say all kinds of evil against you falsely, for my sake. ¹²Rejoice, and be exceedingly glad, for great is your reward in heaven. For that is how they persecuted the prophets who were before you. ^{13a} You are the salt of the earth, but if the salt has lost its flavor, with what will it be salted? It is then good for nothing, but to be cast out and trodden under the feet of men. ¹⁴You are the light of the world. A city located on a hill can’t be hidden. ¹⁵Neither do you light a lamp and put it under a measuring basket, but on a stand; and it shines to all who are in the house. ¹⁶Even so, let your light shine before men, that they may see your good works and glorify your Father who is in heaven. ^{17a} Don’t think that I came to destroy the Torah or the Prophets. I didn’t come to destroy, but to fulfill. ¹⁸For most certainly, I tell you, until

heaven and earth pass away, not even one smallest letter ^{xii} or one tiny pen stroke ^{xiii} shall in any way pass away from the Torah, until all things are accomplished. ¹⁹Therefore, whoever shall break one of these least commandments and teach others to do so, shall be called least in the Kingdom of Heaven; but whoever shall do and teach them shall be called great in the Kingdom of Heaven. ²⁰For I tell you that unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees, there is no way you will enter into the Kingdom of Heaven. ^{21a} You have heard that it was said to the ancient ones, ‘You shall not murder;’ and ‘Whoever murders will be in danger of the judgment.’ ²²But I tell you that everyone who is angry with his brother without a cause ^{xiv} will be in danger of the judgment. Whoever says to his brother, ‘You good-for-nothing!’ ^{xv} will be in danger of the council. Whoever says, ‘You fool!’ will be in danger of the fire of Gehinnom. ^{xvi} ^{23a} If therefore you are offering your gift at the altar, and there remember that your brother has anything against you, ²⁴leave your gift there before the altar, and go your way. First be reconciled to your brother, and then come and offer your gift. ²⁵Agree with your adversary quickly while you are with him on the way; lest perhaps the prosecutor deliver you to the judge, and the judge deliver you to the officer, and you be cast into prison. ²⁶Most certainly I tell you, you shall by no means get out of there until you have paid the last penny. ^{xvii} ^{27a} You have heard that it was said, ^{xviii} ‘You shall not commit adultery;’ ²⁸but I tell you that everyone who gazes at a woman to lust after her has committed adultery with her already in his heart. ²⁹If your right eye causes you to stumble, pluck it out and throw it away from you. For it is more profitable for you that one of your members should perish than for your whole body to be cast into Gehinnom. ^{xix} ³⁰If your right hand causes you to stumble, cut it off, and throw it away from you. For it is more profitable for you that one of your members should perish, than for your whole body to be cast into Gehinnom. ^{xx} ^{31a} It was also said, ‘Whoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a writing of divorce,’ ³²but I tell you that whoever puts away his wife, except for the cause of sexual immorality, makes her an adulteress; and whoever marries her when she is put away commits adultery. ^{33a} Again you have heard that it was said to the ancient ones, ‘You shall not make false vows, but shall perform to the Lord your vows,’ ³⁴but I

^{xii}literally, iota

^{xiii}or, serif

^{xiv}NU omits “without a cause”.

^{xv}“You good-for-nothing” is an Aramaic insult, related to the word for “empty” and conveying the idea of empty-headedness.

^{xvi}or, Hell

^{xvii}literally, kodrantes. A kodrantes was a small copper coin worth about 2 lepta (widow’s mites)—not enough to buy very much of anything.

^{xviii}TR adds “to the ancients”.

^{xix}or, Hell

^{xx}or, Hell

^xTR reads “Yeshua” instead of “he”

^{xi}or, land.

tell you, don't swear at all: neither by heaven, for it is the throne of God; ³⁵nor by the earth, for it is the footstool of his feet; nor by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great King. ³⁶Neither shall you swear by your head, for you can't make one hair white or black. ³⁷But let your 'Yes' be 'Yes' and your 'No' be 'No.' Whatever is more than these is of the evil one. ³⁸"You have heard that it was said, 'An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth.' ³⁹But I tell you, don't resist him who is evil; but whoever strikes you on your right cheek, turn to him the other also. ⁴⁰If anyone sues you to take away your coat, let him have your cloak also. ⁴¹Whoever compels you to go one mile, go with him two. ⁴²Give to him who asks you, and don't turn away him who desires to borrow from you. ⁴³"You have heard that it was said, 'You shall love your neighbor and hate your enemy.' ^{xxi} ⁴⁴But I tell you, love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you, and pray for those who mistreat you and persecute you, ⁴⁵that you may be children of your Father who is in heaven. For he makes his sun to rise on the evil and the good, and sends rain on the just and the unjust. ⁴⁶For if you love those who love you, what reward do you have? Don't even the tax collectors do the same? ⁴⁷If you only greet your friends, what more do you do than others? Don't even the tax collectors ^{xxii} do the same? ⁴⁸Therefore you shall be perfect, just as your Father in heaven is perfect.

6"Be careful that you don't do your charitable giving ^{xxiii} before men, to be seen by them, or else you have no reward from your Father who is in heaven. ²Therefore, when you do merciful deeds, don't sound a shofar before yourself, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may get glory from men. Most certainly I tell you, they have received their reward. ³But when you do merciful deeds, don't let your left hand know what your right hand does, ⁴so that your merciful deeds may be in secret, then your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly. ⁵"When you pray, you shall not be as the hypocrites, for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen by men. Most certainly, I tell you, they have received their reward. ⁶But you, when you pray, enter into your inner room, and having shut your door, pray to your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly. ⁷In praying, don't use vain repetitions as the Gentiles do; for they think that they will be heard for their much speaking. ⁸Therefore don't be like them, for your Father knows what things you need before you ask him. ⁹Pray like this: "'Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy. ¹⁰Let your Kingdom come. Let your will be done on earth as it is in heaven. ¹¹Give us today

our daily bread. ¹²Forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors. ¹³Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one. For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen.' ^{xxiv} ¹⁴"For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. ¹⁵But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses. ¹⁶"Moreover when you fast, don't be like the hypocrites, with sad faces. For they disfigure their faces that they may be seen by men to be fasting. Most certainly I tell you, they have received their reward. ¹⁷But you, when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face, ¹⁸so that you are not seen by men to be fasting, but by your Father who is in secret; and your Father, who sees in secret, will reward you. ¹⁹"Don't lay up treasures for yourselves on the earth, where moth and rust consume, and where thieves break through and steal; ²⁰but lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust consume, and where thieves don't break through and steal; ²¹for where your treasure is, there your heart will be also. ²²"The lamp of the body is the eye. If therefore your eye is sound, your whole body will be full of light. ²³But if your eye is evil, your whole body will be full of darkness. If therefore the light that is in you is darkness, how great is the darkness! ²⁴"No one can serve two masters, for either he will hate the one and love the other, or else he will be devoted to one and despise the other. You can't serve both God and Mammon. ²⁵Therefore I tell you, don't be anxious for your life: what you will eat, or what you will drink; nor yet for your body, what you will wear. Isn't life more than food, and the body more than clothing? ²⁶See the birds of the sky, that they don't sow, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns. Your heavenly Father feeds them. Aren't you of much more value than they? ²⁷"Which of you by being anxious, can add one moment ^{xxv} to his lifespan? ²⁸Why are you anxious about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow. They don't toil, neither do they spin, ²⁹yet I tell you that even Solomon in all his glory was not dressed like one of these. ³⁰But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which today exists and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, won't he much more clothe you, you of little faith? ³¹"Therefore don't be anxious, saying, 'What will we eat?', 'What will we drink?' or, 'With what will we be clothed?' ³²For the Gentiles seek after all these things; for your heavenly Father knows that you need all these things. ³³But seek first God's Kingdom and his righteousness; and all these things will be given to you as well. ³⁴Therefore don't be anxious for tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Each day's own evil is sufficient.

7"Don't judge, so that you won't be judged. ²For with

^{xxi}not in the Bible, but see Qumran Manual of Discipline Ix, 21-26

^{xxii}NU reads "Gentiles" instead of "tax collectors".

^{xxiii}NU reads "acts of righteousness" instead of "charitable giving"

^{xxiv}NU omits "For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen."

^{xxv}literally, cubit

whatever judgment you judge, you will be judged; and with whatever measure you measure, it will be measured to you. ³Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but don't consider the beam that is in your own eye? ⁴Or how will you tell your brother, 'Let me remove the speck from your eye,' and behold, the beam is in your own eye? ⁵You hypocrite! First remove the beam out of your own eye, and then you can see clearly to remove the speck out of your brother's eye. ⁶"Don't give that which is holy to the dogs, neither throw your pearls before the pigs, lest perhaps they trample them under their feet, and turn and tear you to pieces. ⁷"Ask, and it will be given you. Seek, and you will find. Knock, and it will be opened for you. ⁸For everyone who asks receives. He who seeks finds. To him who knocks it will be opened. ⁹Or who is there among you who, if his son asks him for bread, will give him a stone? ¹⁰Or if he asks for a fish, who will give him a serpent? ¹¹If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father who is in heaven give good things to those who ask him! ¹²Therefore, whatever you desire for men to do to you, you shall also do to them; for this is the Torah and the Prophets. ¹³"Enter in by the narrow gate; for the gate is wide and the way is broad that leads to destruction, and there are many who enter in by it. ¹⁴How ^{xxvi} narrow is the gate and the way is restricted that leads to life! There are few who find it. ¹⁵"Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly are ravening wolves. ¹⁶By their fruits you will know them. Do you gather grapes from thorns or figs from thistles? ¹⁷Even so, every good tree produces good fruit, but the corrupt tree produces evil fruit. ¹⁸A good tree can't produce evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree produce good fruit. ¹⁹Every tree that doesn't grow good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. ²⁰Therefore by their fruits you will know them. ²¹"Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter into the Kingdom of Heaven, but he who does the will of my Father who is in heaven. ²²Many will tell me in that day, 'Lord, Lord, didn't we prophesy in your name, in your name cast out demons, and in your name do many mighty works?' ²³Then I will tell them, 'I never knew you. Depart from me, you who work iniquity.' ²⁴"Everyone therefore who hears these words of mine and does them, I will liken him to a wise man who built his house on a rock. ²⁵The rain came down, the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house; and it didn't fall, for it was founded on the rock. ²⁶Everyone who hears these words of mine and doesn't do them will be like a foolish man who built his house on the sand. ²⁷The rain came down, the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house; and it fell—and its fall was great." ²⁸When Yeshua had finished saying these things, the multitudes were astonished at his teaching, ²⁹for he taught them with authority, and not like

the scribes.

⁸When he came down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him. ²Behold, a leper came to him and worshiped him, saying, "Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean." ³Yeshua stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, "I want to. Be made clean." Immediately his leprosy was cleansed. ⁴Yeshua said to him, "See that you tell nobody; but go, show yourself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, as a testimony to them." ⁵When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶saying, "Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented." ⁷Yeshua said to him, "I will come and heal him." ⁸The centurion answered, "Lord, I'm not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. ⁹For I am also a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, 'Go,' and he goes; and tell another, 'Come,' and he comes; and tell my servant, 'Do this,' and he does it." ¹⁰When Yeshua heard it, he marveled and said to those who followed, "Most certainly I tell you, I haven't found so great a faith, not even in Israel. ¹¹I tell you that many will come from the east and the west, and will sit down with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the Kingdom of Heaven, ¹²but the children of the Kingdom will be thrown out into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth." ¹³Yeshua said to the centurion, "Go your way. Let it be done for you as you have believed." His servant was healed in that hour. ¹⁴When Yeshua came into Peter's house, he saw his wife's mother lying sick with a fever. ¹⁵He touched her hand, and the fever left her. So she got up and served him. ^{xxvii} ¹⁶When evening came, they brought to him many possessed with demons. He cast out the spirits with a word, and healed all who were sick, ¹⁷that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through Isaiah the prophet, saying, "He took our infirmities and bore our diseases." ¹⁸Now when Yeshua saw great multitudes around him, he gave the order to depart to the other side. ¹⁹A scribe came and said to him, "Rabbi, I will follow you wherever you go." ²⁰Yeshua said to him, "The foxes have holes and the birds of the sky have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head." ²¹Another of his disciples said to him, "Lord, allow me first to go and bury my father." ²²But Yeshua said to him, "Follow me, and leave the dead to bury their own dead." ²³When he got into a boat, his disciples followed him. ²⁴Behold, a violent storm came up on the sea, so much that the boat was covered with the waves; but he was asleep. ²⁵The disciples came to him and woke him up, saying, "Save us, Lord! We are dying!" ²⁶He said to them, "Why are you fearful, O you of little faith?" Then he got up, rebuked the wind and the sea, and there was a great calm. ²⁷The men marveled, saying, "What kind of man is this, that even the wind and the

^{xxvi}TR reads "Because" instead of "How"

^{xxvii}TR reads "them" instead of "him"

sea obey him?" ²⁸When he came to the other side, into the country of the Gergesenes, ^{xxviii} two people possessed by demons met him there, coming out of the tombs, exceedingly fierce, so that nobody could pass that way. ²⁹Behold, they cried out, saying, "What do we have to do with you, Yeshua, Son of God? Have you come here to torment us before the time?" ³⁰Now there was a herd of many pigs feeding far away from them. ³¹The demons begged him, saying, "If you cast us out, permit us to go away into the herd of pigs." ³²He said to them, "Go!" They came out and went into the herd of pigs; and behold, the whole herd of pigs rushed down the cliff into the sea and died in the water. ³³Those who fed them fled and went away into the city and told everything, including what happened to those who were possessed with demons. ³⁴Behold, all the city came out to meet Yeshua. When they saw him, they begged that he would depart from their borders.

⁹He entered into a boat and crossed over, and came into his own city. ²Behold, they brought to him a man who was paralyzed, lying on a bed. Yeshua, seeing their faith, said to the paralytic, "Son, cheer up! Your sins are forgiven you." ³Behold, some of the scribes said to themselves, "This man blasphemes." ⁴Yeshua, knowing their thoughts, said, "Why do you think evil in your hearts? ⁵For which is easier, to say, 'Your sins are forgiven;' or to say, 'Get up, and walk?' ⁶(But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins—"then he said to the paralytic), "Get up, and take up your mat, and go to your house." ⁷He arose and departed to his house. ⁸But when the multitudes saw it, they marveled and glorified God, who had given such authority to men. ⁹As Yeshua passed by from there, he saw a man called Matthew sitting at the tax collection office. He said to him, "Follow me." He got up and followed him. ¹⁰As he sat in the house, behold, many tax collectors and sinners came and sat down with Yeshua and his disciples. ¹¹When the Pharisees saw it, they said to his disciples, "Why does your rabbi eat with tax collectors and sinners?" ¹²When Yeshua heard it, he said to them, "Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick do. ¹³But you go and learn what this means: 'I desire mercy, and not sacrifice,' for I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance." ^{xxix} ¹⁴Then Yochanan's disciples came to him, saying, "Why do we and the Pharisees fast often, but your disciples don't fast?" ¹⁵Yeshua said to them, "Can the friends of the bridegroom mourn as long as the bridegroom is with them? But the days will come when the bridegroom will be taken away from them, and then they will fast. ¹⁶No one puts a piece of unshrunk cloth on an old garment; for the patch would tear away from the garment, and a worse hole is made. ¹⁷Neither do people

put new wine into old wine skins, or else the skins would burst, and the wine be spilled, and the skins ruined. No, they put new wine into fresh wine skins, and both are preserved." ¹⁸While he told these things to them, behold, a ruler came and worshiped him, saying, "My daughter has just died, but come and lay your hand on her, and she will live." ¹⁹Yeshua got up and followed him, as did his disciples. ²⁰Behold, a woman who had a discharge of blood for twelve years came behind him, and touched the fringe ^{xxx} of his garment; ²¹for she said within herself, "If I just touch his garment, I will be made well." ²²But Yeshua, turning around and seeing her, said, "Daughter, cheer up! Your faith has made you well." And the woman was made well from that hour. ²³When Yeshua came into the ruler's house and saw the flute players and the crowd in noisy disorder, ²⁴he said to them, "Make room, because the girl isn't dead, but sleeping." They were ridiculing him. ²⁵But when the crowd was sent out, he entered in, took her by the hand, and the girl arose. ²⁶The report of this went out into all that land. ²⁷As Yeshua passed by from there, two blind men followed him, calling out and saying, "Have mercy on us, son of David!" ²⁸When he had come into the house, the blind men came to him. Yeshua said to them, "Do you believe that I am able to do this?" They told him, "Yes, Lord." ²⁹Then he touched their eyes, saying, "According to your faith be it done to you." ³⁰Then their eyes were opened. Yeshua strictly commanded them, saying, "See that no one knows about this." ³¹But they went out and spread abroad his fame in all that land. ³²As they went out, behold, a mute man who was demon possessed was brought to him. ³³When the demon was cast out, the mute man spoke. The multitudes marveled, saying, "Nothing like this has ever been seen in Israel!" ³⁴But the Pharisees said, "By the prince of the demons, he casts out demons." ³⁵Yeshua went about all the cities and the villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the Good News of the Kingdom, and healing every disease and every sickness among the people. ³⁶But when he saw the multitudes, he was moved with compassion for them because they were harassed ^{xxxi} and scattered, like sheep without a shepherd. ³⁷Then he said to his disciples, "The harvest indeed is plentiful, but the laborers are few. ³⁸Pray therefore that the Lord of the harvest will send out laborers into his harvest."

¹⁰He called to himself his twelve disciples, and gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal every disease and every sickness. ²Now the names of the twelve emissaries are these. The first, Simon, who is called Peter; Andrew, his brother; Jacob the son of Zebedee; Yochanan, his brother; ³Philip; Bartholomew; Thomas; Matthew the tax collector; Jacob the son of Hal-

^{xxviii}NU reads "Gadarenes"

^{xxix}NU omits "to repentance".

^{xxx}or, tassel

^{xxxi}TR reads "weary" instead of "harassed"

fai; Labbai, who was also called ^{xxxiii} Taddai; ⁴Simon the Zealot; and Judah Iscariot, who also betrayed him. ⁵Yeshua sent these twelve out and commanded them, saying, “Don’t go among the Gentiles, and don’t enter into any city of the Samaritans. ⁶Rather, go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. ⁷As you go, proclaim, saying, ‘The Kingdom of Heaven is at hand!’ ⁸Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, ^{xxxiii} and cast out demons. Freely you received, so freely give. ⁹Don’t take any gold, silver, or brass in your money belts. ¹⁰Take no bag for your journey, neither two coats, nor sandals, nor staff: for the laborer is worthy of his food. ¹¹Into whatever city or village you enter, find out who in it is worthy, and stay there until you go on. ¹²As you enter into the household, greet it. ¹³If the household is worthy, let your peace come on it, but if it isn’t worthy, let your peace return to you. ¹⁴Whoever doesn’t receive you or hear your words, as you go out of that house or that city, shake the dust off your feet. ¹⁵Most certainly I tell you, it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment than for that city. ¹⁶Behold, I send you out as sheep among wolves. Therefore be wise as serpents and harmless as doves. ¹⁷But beware of men, for they will deliver you up to councils, and in their synagogues they will scourge you. ¹⁸Yes, and you will be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony to them and to the nations. ¹⁹But when they deliver you up, don’t be anxious how or what you will say, for it will be given you in that hour what you will say. ²⁰For it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father who speaks in you. ²¹“Brother will deliver up brother to death, and the father his child. Children will rise up against parents and cause them to be put to death. ²²You will be hated by all men for my name’s sake, but he who endures to the end will be saved. ²³But when they persecute you in this city, flee into the next, for most certainly I tell you, you will not have gone through the cities of Israel until the Son of Man has come. ²⁴“A disciple is not above his rabbi, nor a servant above his lord. ²⁵It is enough for the disciple that he be like his rabbi, and the servant like his lord. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebul, ^{xxxiv} how much more those of his household! ²⁶Therefore don’t be afraid of them, for there is nothing covered that will not be revealed, or hidden that will not be known. ²⁷What I tell you in the darkness, speak in the light; and what you hear whispered in the ear, proclaim on the housetops. ²⁸Don’t be afraid of those who kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul. Rather, fear him who is able to destroy both soul and body in Gehinnom. ^{xxxv} ²⁹“Aren’t two sparrows sold for an assarion coin? ^{xxxvi} Not one of them falls to the ground apart

^{xxxiii}NU omits “Labbai, who was also called”

^{xxxiii}TR adds “raise the dead,”

^{xxxiv}Literally, Lord of the Flies, or the devil

^{xxxv}or, Hell.

^{xxxvi}An assarion is a small coin worth one tenth of a drachma or a

from your Father’s will. ³⁰But the very hairs of your head are all numbered. ³¹Therefore don’t be afraid. You are of more value than many sparrows. ³²Everyone therefore who confesses me before men, I will also confess him before my Father who is in heaven. ³³But whoever denies me before men, I will also deny him before my Father who is in heaven. ³⁴“Don’t think that I came to send peace on the earth. I didn’t come to send peace, but a sword. ³⁵For I came to set a man at odds against his father, and a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law. ³⁶A man’s foes will be those of his own household. ³⁷He who loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me; and he who loves son or daughter more than me isn’t worthy of me. ³⁸He who doesn’t take his cross and follow after me isn’t worthy of me. ³⁹He who seeks his life will lose it; and he who loses his life for my sake will find it. ⁴⁰“He who receives you receives me, and he who receives me receives him who sent me. ⁴¹He who receives a prophet in the name of a prophet will receive a prophet’s reward. He who receives a righteous man in the name of a righteous man will receive a righteous man’s reward. ⁴²Whoever gives one of these little ones just a cup of cold water to drink in the name of a disciple, most certainly I tell you, he will in no way lose his reward.”

11When Yeshua had finished directing his twelve disciples, he departed from there to teach and proclaim in their cities. ²Now when Yochanan heard in the prison the works of Messiah, he sent two of his disciples ³and said to him, “Are you he who comes, or should we look for another?” ⁴Yeshua answered them, “Go and tell Yochanan the things which you hear and see: ⁵the blind receive their sight, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have good news preached to them. ⁶Blessed is he who finds no occasion for stumbling in me.” ⁷As these went their way, Yeshua began to say to the multitudes concerning Yochanan, “What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind? ⁸But what did you go out to see? A man in soft clothing? Behold, those who wear soft clothing are in kings’ houses. ⁹But why did you go out? To see a prophet? Yes, I tell you, and much more than a prophet. ¹⁰For this is he, of whom it is written, ‘Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who will prepare your way before you.’ ¹¹Most certainly I tell you, among those who are born of women there has not arisen anyone greater than Yochanan the Immerser; yet he who is least in the Kingdom of Heaven is greater than he. ¹²From the days of Yochanan the Immerser until now, the Kingdom of Heaven suffers violence, and the violent take it by force. ^{xxxvii} ¹³For all the Prophets and the Torah prophesied until Yochanan. ¹⁴If you are willing to receive

sixteenth of a denarius. An assarion is approximately the wages of one half hour of agricultural labor.

^{xxxvii}or, plunder it.

it, this is Elijah, who is to come. ¹⁵He who has ears to hear, let him hear. ¹⁶“ But to what shall I compare this generation? It is like children sitting in the marketplaces, who call to their companions ¹⁷and say, ‘We played the flute for you, and you didn’t dance. We mourned for you, and you didn’t lament.’ ¹⁸For Yochanan came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, ‘He has a demon.’ ¹⁹The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Behold, a gluttonous man and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!’ But wisdom is justified by her children.” ^{xxxviii} ²⁰Then he began to denounce the cities in which most of his mighty works had been done, because they didn’t repent. ²¹“ Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the mighty works had been done in Tyre and Sidon which were done in you, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes. ²²But I tell you, it will be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment than for you. ²³You, Capernaum, who are exalted to heaven, you will go down to Sheol. ^{xxxix} For if the mighty works had been done in Sodom which were done in you, it would have remained until today. ²⁴But I tell you that it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom on the day of judgment, than for you.” ²⁵At that time, Yeshua answered, “ I thank you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that you hid these things from the wise and understanding, and revealed them to infants. ²⁶Yes, Father, for so it was well-pleasing in your sight. ²⁷All things have been delivered to me by my Father. No one knows the Son, except the Father; neither does anyone know the Father, except the Son and he to whom the Son desires to reveal him. ²⁸“ Come to me, all you who labor and are heavily burdened, and I will give you rest. ²⁹Take my yoke upon you and learn from me, for I am gentle and humble in heart; and you will find rest for your souls. ³⁰For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.”

12At that time, Yeshua went on the Sabbath day through the grain fields. His disciples were hungry and began to pluck heads of grain and to eat. ²But the Pharisees, when they saw it, said to him, “Behold, your disciples do what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath.” ³But he said to them, “Haven’t you read what David did when he was hungry, and those who were with him: ⁴how he entered into God’s house and ate the show bread, which was not lawful for him to eat, nor for those who were with him, but only for the priests? ⁵Or have you not read in the law that on the Sabbath day the priests in the temple profane the Sabbath and are guiltless? ⁶But I tell you that one greater than the temple is here. ⁷But if you had known what this means, ‘I desire mercy, and not sacrifice,’ you wouldn’t have condemned the guiltless. ⁸For the Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath.” ⁹He departed from there and went

into their synagogue. ¹⁰And behold, there was a man with a withered hand. They asked him, “Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath day?” so that they might accuse him. ¹¹He said to them, “ What man is there among you who has one sheep, and if this one falls into a pit on the Sabbath day, won’t he grab on to it and lift it out? ¹²Of how much more value then is a man than a sheep! Therefore it is lawful to do good on the Sabbath day.” ¹³Then he told the man, “ Stretch out your hand.” He stretched it out; and it was restored whole, just like the other. ¹⁴But the Pharisees went out and conspired against him, how they might destroy him. ¹⁵Yeshua, perceiving that, withdrew from there. Great multitudes followed him; and he healed them all, ¹⁶and commanded them that they should not make him known, ¹⁷that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through Isaiah the prophet, saying, ¹⁸“Behold, my servant whom I have chosen, my beloved in whom my soul is well pleased. I will put my Spirit on him. He will proclaim justice to the nations. ¹⁹He will not strive, nor shout, neither will anyone hear his voice in the streets. ²⁰He won’t break a bruised reed. He won’t quench a smoking flax, until he leads justice to victory. ²¹In his name, the nations will hope.” ²²Then one possessed by a demon, blind and mute, was brought to him; and he healed him, so that the blind and mute man both spoke and saw. ²³All the multitudes were amazed, and said, “Can this be the son of David?” ²⁴But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, “This man does not cast out demons except by Beelzebul, the prince of the demons.” ²⁵Knowing their thoughts, Yeshua said to them, “ Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation, and every city or house divided against itself will not stand. ²⁶If Satan casts out Satan, he is divided against himself. How then will his kingdom stand? ²⁷If I by Beelzebul cast out demons, by whom do your children cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges. ²⁸But if I by the Spirit of God cast out demons, then God’s Kingdom has come upon you. ²⁹Or how can one enter into the house of the strong man and plunder his goods, unless he first bind the strong man? Then he will plunder his house. ³⁰“ He who is not with me is against me, and he who doesn’t gather with me, scatters. ³¹Therefore I tell you, every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven men, but the blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven men. ³²Whoever speaks a word against the Son of Man, it will be forgiven him; but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit, it will not be forgiven him, either in this age, or in that which is to come. ³³“ Either make the tree good and its fruit good, or make the tree corrupt and its fruit corrupt; for the tree is known by its fruit. ³⁴You offspring of vipers, how can you, being evil, speak good things? For out of the abundance of the heart, the mouth speaks. ³⁵The good man out of his good treasure ^{x1} brings out good things, and the evil man out of his evil treasure brings out evil

^{xxxviii}NU reads “actions” instead of “children”
^{xxxix}or, Hell

^{x1}TR adds “of the heart”

things. ³⁶I tell you that every idle word that men speak, they will give account of it in the day of judgment. ³⁷For by your words you will be justified, and by your words you will be condemned.” ³⁸Then certain of the scribes and Pharisees answered, “Rabbi, we want to see a sign from you.” ³⁹But he answered them, “An evil and adulterous generation seeks after a sign, but no sign will be given to it but the sign of Jonah the prophet. ⁴⁰For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the huge fish, so will the Son of Man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth. ⁴¹The men of Nineveh will stand up in the judgment with this generation and will condemn it, for they repented at the proclaiming of Jonah; and behold, someone greater than Jonah is here. ⁴²The Queen of the South will rise up in the judgment with this generation and will condemn it, for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and behold, someone greater than Solomon is here. ⁴³“When an unclean spirit has gone out of a man, he passes through waterless places seeking rest, and doesn’t find it. ⁴⁴Then he says, ‘I will return into my house from which I came;’ and when he has come back, he finds it empty, swept, and put in order. ⁴⁵Then he goes and takes with himself seven other spirits more evil than he is, and they enter in and dwell there. The last state of that man becomes worse than the first. Even so will it be also to this evil generation.” ⁴⁶While he was yet speaking to the multitudes, behold, his mother and his brothers stood outside, seeking to speak to him. ⁴⁷One said to him, “Behold, your mother and your brothers stand outside, seeking to speak to you.” ⁴⁸But he answered him who spoke to him, “Who is my mother? Who are my brothers?” ⁴⁹He stretched out his hand toward his disciples, and said, “Behold, my mother and my brothers! ⁵⁰For whoever does the will of my Father who is in heaven, he is my brother, and sister, and mother.”

13On that day Yeshua went out of the house and sat by the seaside. ²Great multitudes gathered to him, so that he entered into a boat and sat; and all the multitude stood on the beach. ³He spoke to them many things in parables, saying, “Behold, a farmer went out to sow. ⁴As he sowed, some seeds fell by the roadside, and the birds came and devoured them. ⁵Others fell on rocky ground, where they didn’t have much soil, and immediately they sprang up, because they had no depth of earth. ⁶When the sun had risen, they were scorched. Because they had no root, they withered away. ⁷Others fell among thorns. The thorns grew up and choked them. ⁸Others fell on good soil and yielded fruit: some one hundred times as much, some sixty, and some thirty. ⁹He who has ears to hear, let him hear.” ¹⁰The disciples came, and said to him, “Why do you speak to them in parables?” ¹¹He answered them, “To you it is given to know the mysteries of the Kingdom of Heaven, but it is not given to them. ¹²For whoever

has, to him will be given, and he will have abundance; but whoever doesn’t have, from him will be taken away even that which he has. ¹³Therefore I speak to them in parables, because seeing they don’t see, and hearing, they don’t hear, neither do they understand. ¹⁴In them the prophecy of Isaiah is fulfilled, which says, ‘By hearing you will hear, and will in no way understand; Seeing you will see, and will in no way perceive; ¹⁵for this people’s heart has grown callous, their ears are dull of hearing, and they have closed their eyes; or else perhaps they might perceive with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their heart, and would turn again, and I would heal them.’ ¹⁶“But blessed are your eyes, for they see; and your ears, for they hear. ¹⁷For most certainly I tell you that many prophets and righteous men desired to see the things which you see, and didn’t see them; and to hear the things which you hear, and didn’t hear them. ¹⁸“Hear, then, the parable of the farmer. ¹⁹When anyone hears the word of the Kingdom and doesn’t understand it, the evil one comes and snatches away that which has been sown in his heart. This is what was sown by the roadside. ²⁰What was sown on the rocky places, this is he who hears the word and immediately with joy receives it; ²¹yet he has no root in himself, but endures for a while. When oppression or persecution arises because of the word, immediately he stumbles. ²²What was sown among the thorns, this is he who hears the word, but the cares of this age and the deceitfulness of riches choke the word, and he becomes unfruitful. ²³What was sown on the good ground, this is he who hears the word and understands it, who most certainly bears fruit and produces, some one hundred times as much, some sixty, and some thirty.” ²⁴He set another parable before them, saying, “The Kingdom of Heaven is like a man who sowed good seed in his field, ²⁵but while people slept, his enemy came and sowed darnel weeds ^{xli} also among the wheat, and went away. ²⁶But when the blade sprang up and produced grain, then the darnel weeds appeared also. ²⁷The servants of the householder came and said to him, ‘Sir, didn’t you sow good seed in your field? Where did these darnel weeds come from?’ ²⁸“He said to them, ‘An enemy has done this.’“ The servants asked him, ‘Do you want us to go and gather them up?’ ²⁹“But he said, ‘No, lest perhaps while you gather up the darnel weeds, you root up the wheat with them. ³⁰Let both grow together until the harvest, and in the harvest time I will tell the reapers, “First, gather up the darnel weeds, and bind them in bundles to burn them; but gather the wheat into my barn.”’“ ³¹He set another parable before them, saying, “The Kingdom of Heaven is like a grain of mustard seed which a man took, and sowed in his field, ³²which indeed is smaller than all seeds. But when it is grown, it is greater

^{xli}darnel is a weed grass (probably bearded darnel or *lolium temulentum*) that looks very much like wheat until it is mature, when the difference becomes very apparent.

than the herbs and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in its branches.”³³ He spoke another parable to them. “The Kingdom of Heaven is like yeast which a woman took and hid in three measures^{xlii} of meal, until it was all leavened.”³⁴ Yeshua spoke all these things in parables to the multitudes; and without a parable, he didn’t speak to them,³⁵ that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through the prophet, saying, “I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things hidden from the foundation of the world.”³⁶ Then Yeshua sent the multitudes away, and went into the house. His disciples came to him, saying, “Explain to us the parable of the darnel weeds of the field.”³⁷ He answered them, “He who sows the good seed is the Son of Man,³⁸ the field is the world, the good seeds are the children of the Kingdom, and the darnel weeds are the children of the evil one.³⁹ The enemy who sowed them is the devil. The harvest is the end of the age, and the reapers are angels.⁴⁰ As therefore the darnel weeds are gathered up and burned with fire; so will it be at the end of this age.⁴¹ The Son of Man will send out his angels, and they will gather out of his Kingdom all things that cause stumbling and those who do iniquity,⁴² and will cast them into the furnace of fire. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.⁴³ Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the Kingdom of their Father. He who has ears to hear, let him hear.⁴⁴ Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like treasure hidden in the field, which a man found and hid. In his joy, he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field.⁴⁵ Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like a man who is a merchant seeking fine pearls,⁴⁶ who having found one pearl of great price, he went and sold all that he had and bought it.⁴⁷ Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like a dragnet that was cast into the sea and gathered some fish of every kind,⁴⁸ which, when it was filled, fishermen drew up on the beach. They sat down and gathered the good into containers, but the bad they threw away.⁴⁹ So it will be in the end of the world.^{xliii} The angels will come and separate the wicked from among the righteous,⁵⁰ and will cast them into the furnace of fire. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”⁵¹ Yeshua said to them, “Have you understood all these things?” They answered him, “Yes, Lord.”⁵² He said to them, “Therefore every scribe who has been made a disciple in the Kingdom of Heaven is like a man who is a householder, who brings out of his treasure new and old things.”⁵³ When Yeshua had finished these parables, he departed from there.⁵⁴ Coming into his own country, he taught them in their synagogue, so that they were astonished and said, “Where did this man get this wisdom and these mighty works?⁵⁵ Isn’t this the carpenter’s son? Isn’t his mother called Miriam, and his

brothers Jacob, Yosi, Simon, and Judah?^{xliv} ⁵⁶ Aren’t all of his sisters with us? Where then did this man get all of these things?”⁵⁷ They were offended by him. But Yeshua said to them, “A prophet is not without honor, except in his own country and in his own house.”⁵⁸ He didn’t do many mighty works there because of their unbelief.

14 At that time, Herod the tetrarch heard the report concerning Yeshua,² and said to his servants, “This is Yochanan the Immerser. He is risen from the dead. That is why these powers work in him.”³ For Herod had arrested Yochanan, bound him, and put him in prison for the sake of Herodias, his brother Philip’s wife.⁴ For Yochanan said to him, “It is not lawful for you to have her.”⁵ When he would have put him to death, he feared the multitude, because they counted him as a prophet.⁶ But when Herod’s birthday came, the daughter of Herodias danced among them and pleased Herod.⁷ Therefore he promised with an oath to give her whatever she should ask.⁸ She, being prompted by her mother, said, “Give me here on a platter the head of Yochanan the Immerser.”⁹ The king was grieved, but for the sake of his oaths and of those who sat at the table with him, he commanded it to be given,¹⁰ and he sent and beheaded Yochanan in the prison.¹¹ His head was brought on a platter and given to the young lady; and she brought it to her mother.¹² His disciples came, took the body, and buried it. Then they went and told Yeshua.¹³ Now when Yeshua heard this, he withdrew from there in a boat to a deserted place apart. When the multitudes heard it, they followed him on foot from the cities.¹⁴ Yeshua went out, and he saw a great multitude. He had compassion on them and healed their sick.¹⁵ When evening had come, his disciples came to him, saying, “This place is deserted, and the hour is already late. Send the multitudes away, that they may go into the villages, and buy themselves food.”¹⁶ But Yeshua said to them, “They don’t need to go away. You give them something to eat.”¹⁷ They told him, “We only have here five loaves and two fish.”¹⁸ He said, “Bring them here to me.”¹⁹ He commanded the multitudes to sit down on the grass; and he took the five loaves and the two fish, and looking up to heaven, he blessed, broke and gave the loaves to the disciples; and the disciples gave to the multitudes.²⁰ They all ate and were filled. They took up twelve baskets full of that which remained left over from the broken pieces.²¹ Those who ate were about five thousand men, in addition to women and children.²² Immediately Yeshua made the disciples get into the boat and go ahead of him to the other side, while he sent the multitudes away.²³ After he had sent the multitudes away, he went up into the mountain by himself to pray. When evening had come, he was there alone.²⁴ But the boat was now in the middle of the sea, distressed by the waves, for the wind was contrary.²⁵ In the fourth

^{xlii} literally, three sata. Three sata is about 39 liters or a bit more than a bushel

^{xliii} or, end of the age.

^{xliv} or, Judah

watch of the night, ^{xlv} Yeshua came to them, walking on the sea. ²⁶When the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, "It's a ghost!" and they cried out for fear. ²⁷But immediately Yeshua spoke to them, saying, "Cheer up! It is I! ^{xlvi} Don't be afraid." ²⁸Peter answered him and said, "Lord, if it is you, command me to come to you on the waters." ²⁹He said, "Come!" Peter stepped down from the boat and walked on the waters to come to Yeshua. ³⁰But when he saw that the wind was strong, he was afraid, and beginning to sink, he cried out, saying, "Lord, save me!" ³¹Immediately Yeshua stretched out his hand, took hold of him, and said to him, "You of little faith, why did you doubt?" ³²When they got up into the boat, the wind ceased. ³³Those who were in the boat came and worshiped him, saying, "You are truly the Son of God!" ³⁴When they had crossed over, they came to the land of Gennesaret. ³⁵When the people of that place recognized him, they sent into all that surrounding region and brought to him all who were sick; ³⁶and they begged him that they might just touch the fringe ^{xlvii} of his garment. As many as touched it were made whole.

15 Then Pharisees and scribes came to Yeshua from Jerusalem, saying, ²"Why do your disciples disobey the tradition of the elders? For they don't wash their hands when they eat bread." ³He answered them, "Why do you also disobey the commandment of God because of your tradition? ⁴For God commanded, 'Honor your father and your mother,' and, 'He who speaks evil of father or mother, let him be put to death.' ⁵But you say, 'Whoever may tell his father or his mother, 'Whatever help you might otherwise have gotten from me is a gift devoted to God,' ⁶he shall not honor his father or mother.' You have made the commandment of God void because of your tradition. ⁷You hypocrites! Well did Isaiah prophesy of you, saying, ⁸'These people draw near to me with their mouth, and honor me with their lips; but their heart is far from me. ⁹And they worship me in vain, teaching as doctrine rules made by men.'" ¹⁰He summoned the multitude, and said to them, "Hear, and understand. ¹¹That which enters into the mouth doesn't defile the man; but that which proceeds out of the mouth, this defiles the man." ¹²Then the disciples came and said to him, "Do you know that the Pharisees were offended when they heard this saying?" ¹³But he answered, "Every plant which my heavenly Father didn't plant will be uprooted. ¹⁴Leave them alone. They are blind guides of the blind. If the blind guide the blind, both will fall into a pit." ¹⁵Peter answered him, "Explain the parable to us." ¹⁶So Yeshua said, "Do you also still not understand? ¹⁷Don't you understand that whatever goes

into the mouth passes into the belly and then out of the body? ¹⁸But the things which proceed out of the mouth come out of the heart, and they defile the man. ¹⁹For out of the heart come evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, sexual sins, thefts, false testimony, and blasphemies. ²⁰These are the things which defile the man; but to eat with unwashed hands doesn't defile the man." ²¹Yeshua went out from there and withdrew into the region of Tyre and Sidon. ²²Behold, a Canaanite woman came out from those borders and cried, saying, "Have mercy on me, Lord, you son of David! My daughter is severely possessed by a demon!" ²³But he answered her not a word. His disciples came and begged him, saying, "Send her away; for she cries after us." ²⁴But he answered, "I wasn't sent to anyone but the lost sheep of the house of Israel." ²⁵But she came and worshiped him, saying, "Lord, help me." ²⁶But he answered, "It is not appropriate to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs." ²⁷But she said, "Yes, Lord, but even the dogs eat the crumbs which fall from their masters' table." ²⁸Then Yeshua answered her, "Woman, great is your faith! Be it done to you even as you desire." And her daughter was healed from that hour. ²⁹Yeshua departed from there and came near to the sea of Galilee; and he went up on the mountain and sat there. ³⁰Great multitudes came to him, having with them the lame, blind, mute, maimed, and many others, and they put them down at his feet. He healed them, ³¹so that the multitude wondered when they saw the mute speaking, the injured healed, the lame walking, and the blind seeing—and they glorified the God of Israel. ³²Yeshua summoned his disciples and said, "I have compassion on the multitude, because they have continued with me now three days and have nothing to eat. I don't want to send them away fasting, or they might faint on the way." ³³The disciples said to him, "Where could we get so many loaves in a deserted place as to satisfy so great a multitude?" ³⁴Yeshua said to them, "How many loaves do you have?" They said, "Seven, and a few small fish." ³⁵He commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground; ³⁶and he took the seven loaves and the fish. He gave thanks and broke them, and gave to the disciples, and the disciples to the multitudes. ³⁷They all ate and were filled. They took up seven baskets full of the broken pieces that were left over. ³⁸Those who ate were four thousand men, in addition to women and children. ³⁹Then he sent away the multitudes, got into the boat, and came into the borders of Magdala.

16 The Pharisees and Sadducees came, and testing him, asked him to show them a sign from heaven. ²But he answered them, "When it is evening, you say, 'It will be fair weather, for the sky is red.' ³In the morning, 'It will be foul weather today, for the sky is red and threatening.' Hypocrites! You know how to discern the appearance of the sky, but you can't discern the signs of the times! ⁴An

^{xlv}The night was equally divided into four watches, so the fourth watch is approximately 3:00 a.m. to sunrise.

^{xlvi}or, I AM!

^{xlvii}or, tassel

evil and adulterous generation seeks after a sign, and there will be no sign given to it, except the sign of the prophet Jonah.” He left them and departed. ⁵The disciples came to the other side and had forgotten to take bread. ⁶Yeshua said to them, “Take heed and beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and Sadducees.” ⁷They reasoned among themselves, saying, “We brought no bread.” ⁸Yeshua, perceiving it, said, “Why do you reason among yourselves, you of little faith, because you have brought no bread? ⁹Don’t you yet perceive or remember the five loaves for the five thousand, and how many baskets you took up, ¹⁰or the seven loaves for the four thousand, and how many baskets you took up? ¹¹How is it that you don’t perceive that I didn’t speak to you concerning bread? But beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and Sadducees.” ¹²Then they understood that he didn’t tell them to beware of the yeast of bread, but of the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees. ¹³Now when Yeshua came into the parts of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, saying, “Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?” ¹⁴They said, “Some say Yochanan the Immerser, some, Elijah, and others, Jeremiah or one of the prophets.” ¹⁵He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” ¹⁶Simon Peter answered, “You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” ¹⁷Yeshua answered him, “Blessed are you, Simon Bar Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven. ¹⁸I also tell you that you are Peter, ^{xlviii} and on this rock ^{xlix} I will build my assembly, and the gates of Sheol ¹ will not prevail against it. ¹⁹I will give to you the keys of the Kingdom of Heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will have been bound in heaven; and whatever you release on earth will have been released in heaven.” ²⁰Then he commanded the disciples that they should tell no one that he was Yeshua the Messiah. ²¹From that time, Yeshua began to show his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem and suffer many things from the elders, chief priests, and scribes, and be killed, and the third day be raised up. ²²Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him, saying, “Far be it from you, Lord! This will never be done to you.” ²³But he turned and said to Peter, “Get behind me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to me, for you are not setting your mind on the things of God, but on the things of men.” ²⁴Then Yeshua said to his disciples, “If anyone desires to come after me, let him deny himself, take up his cross, and follow me. ²⁵For whoever desires to save his life will lose it, and whoever will lose his life for my sake will find it. ²⁶For what will it profit a man if he gains the whole world and forfeits his life? Or what will a man give in exchange for his life? ²⁷For the Son of Man will come in the glory of his Father with his angels, and then he will render to everyone

according to his deeds. ²⁸Most certainly I tell you, there are some standing here who will in no way taste of death until they see the Son of Man coming in his Kingdom.”

¹⁷After six days, Yeshua took with him Peter, Jacob, and Yochanan his brother, and brought them up into a high mountain by themselves. ²He was changed ^{li} before them. His face shone like the sun, and his garments became as white as the light. ³Behold, Moses and Elijah appeared to them talking with him. ⁴Peter answered and said to Yeshua, “Lord, it is good for us to be here. If you want, let’s make three tents here: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.” ⁵While he was still speaking, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them. Behold, a voice came out of the cloud, saying, “This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased. Listen to him.” ⁶When the disciples heard it, they fell on their faces, and were very afraid. ⁷Yeshua came and touched them and said, “Get up, and don’t be afraid.” ⁸Lifting up their eyes, they saw no one, except Yeshua alone. ⁹As they were coming down from the mountain, Yeshua commanded them, saying, “Don’t tell anyone what you saw, until the Son of Man has risen from the dead.” ¹⁰His disciples asked him, saying, “Then why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?” ¹¹Yeshua answered them, “Elijah indeed comes first, and will restore all things; ¹²but I tell you that Elijah has come already, and they didn’t recognize him, but did to him whatever they wanted to. Even so the Son of Man will also suffer by them.” ¹³Then the disciples understood that he spoke to them of Yochanan the Immerser. ¹⁴When they came to the multitude, a man came to him, kneeling down to him and saying, ¹⁵“Lord, have mercy on my son, for he is epileptic and suffers grievously; for he often falls into the fire, and often into the water. ¹⁶So I brought him to your disciples, and they could not cure him.” ¹⁷Yeshua answered, “Faithless and perverse generation! How long will I be with you? How long will I bear with you? Bring him here to me.” ¹⁸Yeshua rebuked the demon, and it went out of him, and the boy was cured from that hour. ¹⁹Then the disciples came to Yeshua privately, and said, “Why weren’t we able to cast it out?” ²⁰He said to them, “Because of your unbelief. For most certainly I tell you, if you have faith as a grain of mustard seed, you will tell this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move; and nothing will be impossible for you. ²¹But this kind doesn’t go out except by prayer and fasting.” ^{lii} ²²While they were staying in Galilee, Yeshua said to them, “The Son of Man is about to be delivered up into the hands of men, ²³and they will kill him, and the third day he will be raised up.” They were exceedingly sorry. ²⁴When they had come to Capernaum, those who collected the

^{xlviii}Peter’s name, Petros in Greek, is the word for a specific rock or stone.

^{xlix}Greek, petra, a rock mass or bedrock.

¹or, Hell

^{li}or, transfigured

^{lii}NU omits verse 21.

didrachma coins ^{liii} came to Peter, and said, “Doesn’t your rabbi pay the didrachma?” ²⁵He said, “Yes.” When he came into the house, Yeshua anticipated him, saying, “What do you think, Simon? From whom do the kings of the earth receive toll or tribute? From their children, or from strangers?” ²⁶Peter said to him, “From strangers.” Yeshua said to him, “Therefore the children are exempt. ²⁷But, lest we cause them to stumble, go to the sea, cast a hook, and take up the first fish that comes up. When you have opened its mouth, you will find a stater coin. ^{liv} Take that, and give it to them for me and you.”

18In that hour the disciples came to Yeshua, saying, “Who then is greatest in the Kingdom of Heaven?” ²Yeshua called a little child to himself, and set him in the middle of them ³and said, “Most certainly I tell you, unless you turn and become as little children, you will in no way enter into the Kingdom of Heaven. ⁴Whoever therefore humbles himself as this little child is the greatest in the Kingdom of Heaven. ⁵Whoever receives one such little child in my name receives me, ⁶but whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to stumble, it would be better for him if a huge millstone were hung around his neck and that he were sunk in the depths of the sea. ⁷“Woe to the world because of occasions of stumbling! For it must be that the occasions come, but woe to that person through whom the occasion comes! ⁸If your hand or your foot causes you to stumble, cut it off and cast it from you. It is better for you to enter into life maimed or crippled, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into the eternal fire. ⁹If your eye causes you to stumble, pluck it out and cast it from you. It is better for you to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into the Gehinnom ^{lv} of fire. ¹⁰See that you don’t despise one of these little ones, for I tell you that in heaven their angels always see the face of my Father who is in heaven. ¹¹For the Son of Man came to save that which was lost. ^{lvi} ¹²“What do you think? If a man has one hundred sheep, and one of them goes astray, doesn’t he leave the ninety-nine, go to the mountains, and seek that which has gone astray? ¹³If he finds it, most certainly I tell you, he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine which have not gone astray. ¹⁴Even so it is not the will of your Father who is in heaven that one of these little ones should perish. ¹⁵“If your brother sins against you, go, show him his fault between

you and him alone. If he listens to you, you have gained back your brother. ¹⁶But if he doesn’t listen, take one or two more with you, that at the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established. ¹⁷If he refuses to listen to them, tell it to the assembly. If he refuses to hear the assembly also, let him be to you as a Gentile or a tax collector. ¹⁸Most certainly I tell you, whatever things you bind on earth will have been bound in heaven, and whatever things you release on earth will have been released in heaven. ¹⁹Again, assuredly I tell you, that if two of you will agree on earth concerning anything that they will ask, it will be done for them by my Father who is in heaven. ²⁰For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there I am in the middle of them.” ²¹Then Peter came and said to him, “Lord, how often shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? Until seven times?” ²²Yeshua said to him, “I don’t tell you until seven times, but, until seventy times seven. ²³Therefore the Kingdom of Heaven is like a certain king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants. ²⁴When he had begun to settle, one was brought to him who owed him ten thousand talents. ^{lvii} ²⁵But because he couldn’t pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, with his wife, his children, and all that he had, and payment to be made. ²⁶The servant therefore fell down and knelt before him, saying, ‘Lord, have patience with me, and I will repay you all!’ ²⁷The lord of that servant, being moved with compassion, released him and forgave him the debt. ²⁸“But that servant went out and found one of his fellow servants who owed him one hundred denarii, ^{lviii} and he grabbed him and took him by the throat, saying, ‘Pay me what you owe!’ ²⁹“So his fellow servant fell down at his feet and begged him, saying, ‘Have patience with me, and I will repay you!’ ³⁰He would not, but went and cast him into prison until he should pay back that which was due. ³¹So when his fellow servants saw what was done, they were exceedingly sorry, and came and told their lord all that was done. ³²Then his lord called him in and said to him, ‘You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt because you begged me. ³³Shouldn’t you also have had mercy on your fellow servant, even as I had mercy on you?’ ³⁴His lord was angry, and delivered him to the tormentors until he should pay all that was due to him. ³⁵So my heavenly Father will also do to you, if you don’t each forgive your brother from your hearts for his misdeeds.”

19When Yeshua had finished these words, he departed from Galilee and came into the borders of Judea beyond the Jordan. ²Great multitudes followed him, and he healed them there. ³Pharisees came to him, testing him and say-

^{liii}A didrachma is a Greek silver coin worth 2 drachmas, about as much as 2 Roman denarii, or about 2 days’ wages. It was commonly used to pay the half-shekel temple tax, because 2 drachmas were worth one half shekel of silver. A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

^{liv}A stater is a silver coin equivalent to four Attic or two Alexandrian drachmas, or a Jewish shekel: just exactly enough to cover the half-shekel temple tax for two people. A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, usually in the form of a silver coin.

^{lv}or, Hell

^{lvi}NU omits verse 11.

^{lvii}Ten thousand talents (about 300 metric tons of silver) represents an extremely large sum of money, equivalent to about 60,000,000 denarii, where one denarius was typical of one day’s wages for agricultural labor.

^{lviii}100 denarii was about one sixtieth of a talent, or about 500 grams (1.1 pounds) of silver.

ing, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any reason?" ⁴He answered, "Haven't you read that he who made them from the beginning made them male and female, ⁵and said, 'For this cause a man shall leave his father and mother, and shall be joined to his wife; and the two shall become one flesh?' ⁶So that they are no more two, but one flesh. What therefore God has joined together, don't let man tear apart." ⁷They asked him, "Why then did Moses command us to give her a certificate of divorce and divorce her?" ⁸He said to them, "Moses, because of the hardness of your hearts, allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it has not been so. ⁹I tell you that whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another, commits adultery; and he who marries her when she is divorced commits adultery." ¹⁰His disciples said to him, "If this is the case of the man with his wife, it is not expedient to marry." ¹¹But he said to them, "Not all men can receive this saying, but those to whom it is given. ¹²For there are eunuchs who were born that way from their mother's womb, and there are eunuchs who were made eunuchs by men; and there are eunuchs who made themselves eunuchs for the Kingdom of Heaven's sake. He who is able to receive it, let him receive it." ¹³Then little children were brought to him that he should lay his hands on them and pray; and the disciples rebuked them. ¹⁴But Yeshua said, "Allow the little children, and don't forbid them to come to me; for the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to ones like these." ¹⁵He laid his hands on them, and departed from there. ¹⁶Behold, one came to him and said, "Good Rabbi, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?" ¹⁷He said to him, "Why do you call me good? ^{lix} No one is good but one, that is, God. But if you want to enter into life, keep the commandments." ¹⁸He said to him, "Which ones?" Yeshua said, "'You shall not murder.' 'You shall not commit adultery.' 'You shall not steal.' 'You shall not offer false testimony.' ¹⁹'Honor your father and your mother.' And, 'You shall love your neighbor as yourself.'" ²⁰The young man said to him, "All these things I have observed from my youth. What do I still lack?" ²¹Yeshua said to him, "If you want to be perfect, go, sell what you have, and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me." ²²But when the young man heard this, he went away sad, for he was one who had great possessions. ²³Yeshua said to his disciples, "Most certainly I say to you, a rich man will enter into the Kingdom of Heaven with difficulty. ²⁴Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye than for a rich man to enter into God's Kingdom." ²⁵When the disciples heard it, they were exceedingly astonished, saying, "Who then can be saved?" ²⁶Looking at them, Yeshua said, "With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible."

^{lix}So MT and TR. NU reads "Why do you ask me about what is good?"

²⁷Then Peter answered, "Behold, we have left everything and followed you. What then will we have?" ²⁸Yeshua said to them, "Most certainly I tell you that you who have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of Man will sit on the throne of his glory, you also will sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. ²⁹Everyone who has left houses, or brothers, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, will receive one hundred times, and will inherit eternal life. ³⁰But many will be last who are first, and first who are last.

20 For the Kingdom of Heaven is like a man who was the master of a household, who went out early in the morning to hire laborers for his vineyard. ²When he had agreed with the laborers for a denarius ^{lx} a day, he sent them into his vineyard. ³He went out about the third hour, ^{lxi} and saw others standing idle in the marketplace. ⁴He said to them, 'You also go into the vineyard, and whatever is right I will give you.' So they went their way. ⁵Again he went out about the sixth and the ninth hour, ^{lxii} and did likewise. ⁶About the eleventh hour ^{lxiii} he went out and found others standing idle. He said to them, 'Why do you stand here all day idle?' ⁷They said to him, 'Because no one has hired us.' ⁸He said to them, 'You also go into the vineyard, and you will receive whatever is right.' ⁹When evening had come, the lord of the vineyard said to his manager, 'Call the laborers and pay them their wages, beginning from the last to the first.' ¹⁰When those who were hired at about the eleventh hour came, they each received a denarius. ¹¹When the first came, they supposed that they would receive more; and they likewise each received a denarius. ¹²When they received it, they murmured against the master of the household, ¹³saying, 'These last have spent one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have borne the burden of the day and the scorching heat!' ¹⁴But he answered one of them, 'Friend, I am doing you no wrong. Didn't you agree with me for a denarius?' ¹⁵Take that which is yours, and go your way. It is my desire to give to this last just as much as to you. ¹⁶Isn't it lawful for me to do what I want to with what I own? Or is your eye evil, because I am good?' ¹⁷So the last will be first, and the first last. For many are called, but few are chosen." ¹⁸As Yeshua was going up to Jerusalem, he took the twelve disciples aside, and on the way he said to them, ¹⁹Behold, we are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be delivered to the chief priests and scribes, and they will condemn him to death, ²⁰and will hand him over to the Gentiles to mock, to scourge, and to crucify; and the

^{lx}A denarius is a silver Roman coin worth 1/25th of a Roman aureus. This was a common wage for a day of farm labor.

^{lxi}Time was measured from sunrise to sunset, so the third hour would be about 9:00 a.m.

^{lxii}noon and 3:00 p.m.

^{lxiii}5:00 p.m.

third day he will be raised up.”²⁰ Then the mother of the sons of Zebedee came to him with her sons, kneeling and asking a certain thing of him.²¹ He said to her, “What do you want?” She said to him, “Command that these, my two sons, may sit, one on your right hand and one on your left hand, in your Kingdom.”²² But Yeshua answered, “You don’t know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I am about to drink, and be immersed with the immersion that I am immersed with?” They said to him, “We are able.”²³ He said to them, “You will indeed drink my cup, and be immersed with the immersion that I am immersed with; but to sit on my right hand and on my left hand is not mine to give, but it is for whom it has been prepared by my Father.”²⁴ When the ten heard it, they were indignant with the two brothers.²⁵ But Yeshua summoned them, and said, “You know that the rulers of the nations lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them.²⁶ It shall not be so among you; but whoever desires to become great among you shall be ^{lxiv} your servant.²⁷ Whoever desires to be first among you shall be your bondservant,²⁸ even as the Son of Man came not to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.”²⁹ As they went out from Jericho, a great multitude followed him.³⁰ Behold, two blind men sitting by the road, when they heard that Yeshua was passing by, cried out, “Lord, have mercy on us, you son of David!”³¹ The multitude rebuked them, telling them that they should be quiet, but they cried out even more, “Lord, have mercy on us, you son of David!”³² Yeshua stood still and called them, and asked, “What do you want me to do for you?”³³ They told him, “Lord, that our eyes may be opened.”³⁴ Yeshua, being moved with compassion, touched their eyes; and immediately their eyes received their sight, and they followed him.

21 When they came near to Jerusalem and came to Bethsphage, ^{lxv} to the Mount of Olives, then Yeshua sent two disciples,² saying to them, “Go into the village that is opposite you, and immediately you will find a donkey tied, and a colt with her. Untie them and bring them to me.³ If anyone says anything to you, you shall say, ‘The Lord needs them,’ and immediately he will send them.”⁴ All this was done that it might be fulfilled which was spoken through the prophet, saying,⁵ “Tell the daughter of Zion, behold, your King comes to you, humble, and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.”⁶ The disciples went and did just as Yeshua commanded them,⁷ and brought the donkey and the colt and laid their clothes on them; and he sat on them.⁸ A very great multitude spread their clothes on the road. Others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road.⁹ The multitudes who went in front of him, and those who followed, kept shout-

ing, “Hoshia’na ^{lxvi} to the son of David! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! Hoshia’na in the highest!”¹⁰ When he had come into Jerusalem, all the city was stirred up, saying, “Who is this?”¹¹ The multitudes said, “This is the prophet, Yeshua, from Nazareth of Galilee.”¹² Yeshua entered into the temple of God and drove out all of those who sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the money changers’ tables and the seats of those who sold the doves.¹³ He said to them, “It is written, ‘My house shall be called a house of prayer,’ but you have made it a den of robbers!”¹⁴ The lame and the blind came to him in the temple, and he healed them.¹⁵ But when the chief priests and the scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children who were crying in the temple and saying, “Hoshia’na to the son of David!” they were indignant,¹⁶ and said to him, “Do you hear what these are saying?” Yeshua said to them, “Yes. Did you never read, ‘Out of the mouth of children and nursing babies, you have perfected praise?’”¹⁷ He left them and went out of the city to Bethany, and camped there.¹⁸ Now in the morning, as he returned to the city, he was hungry.¹⁹ Seeing a fig tree by the road, he came to it and found nothing on it but leaves. He said to it, “Let there be no fruit from you forever!” Immediately the fig tree withered away.²⁰ When the disciples saw it, they marveled, saying, “How did the fig tree immediately wither away?”²¹ Yeshua answered them, “Most certainly I tell you, if you have faith and don’t doubt, you will not only do what was done to the fig tree, but even if you told this mountain, ‘Be taken up and cast into the sea,’ it would be done.²² All things, whatever you ask in prayer, believing, you will receive.”²³ When he had come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came to him as he was teaching, and said, “By what authority do you do these things? Who gave you this authority?”²⁴ Yeshua answered them, “I also will ask you one question, which if you tell me, I likewise will tell you by what authority I do these things.²⁵ The immersion of Yochanan, where was it from? From heaven or from men?” They reasoned with themselves, saying, “If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will ask us, ‘Why then did you not believe him?’²⁶ But if we say, ‘From men,’ we fear the multitude, for all hold Yochanan as a prophet.”²⁷ They answered Yeshua, and said, “We don’t know.” He also said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.²⁸ But what do you think? A man had two sons, and he came to the first, and said, ‘Son, go work today in my vineyard.’²⁹ He answered, ‘I will not,’ but afterward he changed his mind, and went.³⁰ He came to the second, and said the same thing. He answered, ‘I’m going, sir,’ but he didn’t go.³¹ Which of the two did the will of his father?” They said to him, “The first.” Yeshua said to them, “Most certainly I tell you that the tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering into God’s Kingdom before you.

^{lxiv}TR reads “let him be” instead of “shall be”

^{lxv}TR & NU read “Bethphage” instead of “Bethsphage”

^{lxvi}“Hoshia’na” means “save us” or “help us, we pray”.

³²For Yochanan came to you in the way of righteousness, and you didn't believe him; but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him. When you saw it, you didn't even repent afterward, that you might believe him. ³³"Hear another parable. There was a man who was a master of a household who planted a vineyard, set a hedge about it, dug a wine press in it, built a tower, leased it out to farmers, and went into another country. ³⁴When the season for the fruit came near, he sent his servants to the farmers to receive his fruit. ³⁵The farmers took his servants, beat one, killed another, and stoned another. ³⁶Again, he sent other servants more than the first; and they treated them the same way. ³⁷But afterward he sent to them his son, saying, 'They will respect my son.' ³⁸But the farmers, when they saw the son, said among themselves, 'This is the heir. Come, let's kill him and seize his inheritance.' ³⁹So they took him and threw him out of the vineyard, then killed him. ⁴⁰When therefore the lord of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those farmers?" ⁴¹They told him, "He will miserably destroy those miserable men, and will lease out the vineyard to other farmers who will give him the fruit in its season." ⁴²Yeshua said to them, "Did you never read in the Scriptures, 'The stone which the builders rejected was made the head of the corner. This was from the Lord. It is marvelous in our eyes'?" ⁴³"Therefore I tell you, God's Kingdom will be taken away from you and will be given to a nation producing its fruit. ⁴⁴He who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces, but on whomever it will fall, it will scatter him as dust." ⁴⁵When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they perceived that he spoke about them. ⁴⁶When they sought to seize him, they feared the multitudes, because they considered him to be a prophet.

22Yeshua answered and spoke to them again in parables, saying, ²"The Kingdom of Heaven is like a certain king, who made a wedding feast for his son, ³and sent out his servants to call those who were invited to the wedding feast, but they would not come. ⁴Again he sent out other servants, saying, 'Tell those who are invited, "Behold, I have prepared my dinner. My cattle and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready. Come to the wedding feast!"' ⁵But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his own farm, another to his merchandise; ⁶and the rest grabbed his servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them. ⁷When the king heard that, he was angry, and sent his armies, destroyed those murderers, and burned their city. ⁸"Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding is ready, but those who were invited weren't worthy. ⁹Go therefore to the intersections of the highways, and as many as you may find, invite to the wedding feast.' ¹⁰Those servants went out into the highways and gathered together as many as they found, both bad and good. The wedding was filled with guests. ¹¹"But when the king came in to see the

guests, he saw there a man who didn't have on wedding clothing, ¹²and he said to him, 'Friend, how did you come in here not wearing wedding clothing?' He was speechless. ¹³Then the king said to the servants, 'Bind him hand and foot, take him away, and throw him into the outer darkness. That is where the weeping and grinding of teeth will be.' ¹⁴For many are called, but few chosen." ¹⁵Then the Pharisees went and took counsel how they might entrap him in his talk. ¹⁶They sent their disciples to him, along with the Herodians, saying, "Rabbi, we know that you are honest, and teach the way of God in truth, no matter whom you teach; for you aren't partial to anyone. ¹⁷Tell us therefore, what do you think? Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?" ¹⁸But Yeshua perceived their wickedness, and said, "Why do you test me, you hypocrites? ¹⁹Show me the tax money." They brought to him a denarius. ²⁰He asked them, "Whose is this image and inscription?" ²¹They said to him, "Caesar's." Then he said to them, "Give therefore to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's." ²²When they heard it, they marveled, and left him and went away. ²³On that day Sadducees (those who say that there is no resurrection) came to him. They asked him, ²⁴saying, "Rabbi, Moses said, 'If a man dies, having no children, his brother shall marry his wife and raise up offspring ^{lxvii} for his brother.' ²⁵Now there were with us seven brothers. The first married and died, and having no offspring left his wife to his brother. ²⁶In the same way, the second also, and the third, to the seventh. ²⁷After them all, the woman died. ²⁸In the resurrection therefore, whose wife will she be of the seven? For they all had her." ²⁹But Yeshua answered them, "You are mistaken, not knowing the Scriptures, nor the power of God. ³⁰For in the resurrection they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are like God's angels in heaven. ³¹But concerning the resurrection of the dead, haven't you read that which was spoken to you by God, saying, ³²'I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob?' God is not the God of the dead, but of the living." ³³When the multitudes heard it, they were astonished at his teaching. ³⁴But the Pharisees, when they heard that he had silenced the Sadducees, gathered themselves together. ³⁵One of them, a Torah scholar, asked him a question, testing him. ³⁶"Rabbi, which is the greatest commandment in the law?" ³⁷Yeshua said to him, "'You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your mind.' ³⁸This is the first and great commandment. ³⁹A second likewise is this, 'You shall love your neighbor as yourself.' ⁴⁰The whole Torah and the Prophets depend on these two commandments." ⁴¹Now while the Pharisees were gathered together, Yeshua asked them a question, ⁴²saying, "What do you think of the Messiah? Whose son is he?" They said to him, "Of David." ⁴³He said to them, "How then does David in the

^{lxvii}or, seed

Spirit call him Lord, saying, ⁴⁴“The Lord said to my Lord, sit on my right hand, until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet?” ⁴⁵“If then David calls him Lord, how is he his son?” ⁴⁶No one was able to answer him a word, neither did any man dare ask him any more questions from that day forward.

23 Then Yeshua spoke to the multitudes and to his disciples, ²saying, “The scribes and the Pharisees sit on Moses’ seat. ³All things therefore whatever they tell you to observe, observe and do, but don’t do their works; for they say, and don’t do. ⁴For they bind heavy burdens that are grievous to be borne, and lay them on men’s shoulders; but they themselves will not lift a finger to help them. ⁵But they do all their works to be seen by men. They make their phylacteries ^{lxviii} broad and enlarge the fringes ^{lxix} of their garments, ⁶and love the place of honor at feasts, the best seats in the synagogues, ⁷the salutations in the marketplaces, and to be called ‘Rabbi, Rabbi ^{lxx} by men. ⁸But you are not to be called ‘Rabbi’, for one is your Rabbi, the Messiah, and all of you are brothers. ⁹Call no man on the earth your father, for one is your Father, he who is in heaven. ¹⁰Neither be called masters, for one is your master, the Messiah. ¹¹But he who is greatest among you will be your servant. ¹²Whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted. ¹³“Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you devour widows’ houses, and as a pretense you make long prayers. Therefore you will receive greater condemnation. ¹⁴“But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! Because you shut up the Kingdom of Heaven against men; for you don’t enter in yourselves, neither do you allow those who are entering in to enter. ^{lxxi} ¹⁵Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you travel around by sea and land to make one proselyte; and when he becomes one, you make him twice as much a son of Gehinnom ^{lxxii} as yourselves. ¹⁶“Woe to you, you blind guides, who say, ‘Whoever swears by the temple, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gold of the temple, he is obligated.’ ¹⁷You blind fools! For which is greater, the gold or the temple that sanctifies the gold? ¹⁸And, ‘Whoever swears by the altar, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gift that is on it, he is obligated?’ ¹⁹You blind fools! For which is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifies the gift? ²⁰He therefore who swears by the altar, swears by it and by everything on it. ²¹He who swears by the temple, swears by

it and by him who has been living ^{lxxiii} in it. ²²He who swears by heaven, swears by the throne of God and by him who sits on it. ²³“Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you tithe mint, dill, and cumin, ^{lxxiv} and have left undone the weightier matters of the Torah: justice, mercy, and faith. But you ought to have done these, and not to have left the other undone. ²⁴You blind guides, who strain out a gnat, and swallow a camel! ²⁵“Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you clean the outside of the cup and of the platter, but within they are full of extortion and unrighteousness. ^{lxxv} ²⁶You blind Pharisee, first clean the inside of the cup and of the platter, that its outside may become clean also. ²⁷“Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like whitened tombs, which outwardly appear beautiful, but inwardly are full of dead men’s bones and of all uncleanness. ²⁸Even so you also outwardly appear righteous to men, but inwardly you are full of hypocrisy and iniquity. ²⁹“Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you build the tombs of the prophets and decorate the tombs of the righteous, ³⁰and say, ‘If we had lived in the days of our fathers, we wouldn’t have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.’ ³¹Therefore you testify to yourselves that you are children of those who killed the prophets. ³²Fill up, then, the measure of your fathers. ³³You serpents, you offspring of vipers, how will you escape the judgment of Gehinnom? ^{lxxvi} ³⁴Therefore, behold, I send to you prophets, wise men, and scribes. Some of them you will kill and crucify; and some of them you will scourge in your synagogues and persecute from city to city, ³⁵that on you may come all the righteous blood shed on the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah son of Berechiah, whom you killed between the sanctuary and the altar. ³⁶Most certainly I tell you, all these things will come upon this generation. ³⁷“Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I would have gathered your children together, even as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, and you would not! ³⁸Behold, your house is left to you desolate. ³⁹For I tell you, you will not see me from now on, until you say, ‘Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!’”

24 Yeshua went out from the temple, and was going on his way. His disciples came to him to show him the buildings of the temple. ²But he answered them, “You see all of these things, don’t you? Most certainly I tell you, there will not be left here one stone on another, that will not be thrown down.” ³As he sat on the Mount of

^{lxviii}phylacteries (tefillin in Hebrew) are small leather pouches that some Jewish men wear on their forehead and arm in prayer. They are used to carry a small scroll with some Scripture in it. See

^{lxix}or, tzitzitot

^{lxx}NU omits the second “Rabbi”.

^{lxxi}Some Greek texts reverse the order of verses 13 and 14, and some omit verse 13, numbering verse 14 as 13. NU omits verse 14.

^{lxxii}or, Hell

^{lxxiii}NU reads “lives”

^{lxxiv}cumin is an aromatic seed from *Cuminum cyminum*, resembling caraway in flavor and appearance. It is used as a spice.

^{lxxv}TR reads “self-indulgence” instead of “unrighteousness”

^{lxxvi}or, Hell

Olives, the disciples came to him privately, saying, "Tell us, when will these things be? What is the sign of your coming, and of the end of the age?" ⁴Yeshua answered them, "Be careful that no one leads you astray. ⁵For many will come in my name, saying, 'I am the Messiah,' and will lead many astray. ⁶You will hear of wars and rumors of wars. See that you aren't troubled, for all this must happen, but the end is not yet. ⁷For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom; and there will be famines, plagues, and earthquakes in various places. ⁸But all these things are the beginning of birth pains. ⁹" Then they will deliver you up to oppression and will kill you. You will be hated by all of the nations for my name's sake. ¹⁰Then many will stumble, and will deliver up one another, and will hate one another. ¹¹Many false prophets will arise and will lead many astray. ¹²Because iniquity will be multiplied, the love of many will grow cold. ¹³But he who endures to the end will be saved. ¹⁴This Good News of the Kingdom will be preached in the whole world for a testimony to all the nations, and then the end will come. ¹⁵"When, therefore, you see the abomination of desolation, which was spoken of through Daniel the prophet, standing in the holy place (let the reader understand), ¹⁶then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains. ¹⁷Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take out the things that are in his house. ¹⁸Let him who is in the field not return back to get his clothes. ¹⁹But woe to those who are with child and to nursing mothers in those days! ²⁰Pray that your flight will not be in the winter nor on a Sabbath, ²¹for then there will be great suffering, ^{lxxvii} such as has not been from the beginning of the world until now, no, nor ever will be. ²²Unless those days had been shortened, no flesh would have been saved. But for the sake of the chosen ones, those days will be shortened. ²³" Then if any man tells you, 'Behold, here is the Messiah!' or, 'There!' don't believe it. ²⁴For false messiahs and false prophets will arise, and they will show great signs and wonders, so as to lead astray, if possible, even the chosen ones. ²⁵" Behold, I have told you beforehand. ²⁶" If therefore they tell you, 'Behold, he is in the wilderness,' don't go out; or 'Behold, he is in the inner rooms,' don't believe it. ²⁷For as the lightning flashes from the east, and is seen even to the west, so will the coming of the Son of Man be. ²⁸For wherever the carcass is, that is where the vultures ^{lxxviii} gather together. ²⁹"But immediately after the suffering ^{lxxix} of those days, the sun will be darkened, the moon will not give its light, the stars will fall from the sky, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken; ³⁰and then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in the sky. Then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of the sky with power

and great glory. ³¹He will send out his angels with a great sound of a shofar, and they will gather together his chosen ones from the four winds, from one end of the sky to the other. ³²" Now from the fig tree learn this parable: When its branch has now become tender and produces its leaves, you know that the summer is near. ³³Even so you also, when you see all these things, know that he is near, even at the doors. ³⁴Most certainly I tell you, this generation ^{lxxx} will not pass away until all these things are accomplished. ³⁵Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away. ³⁶"But no one knows of that day and hour, not even the angels of heaven, ^{lxxxi} but my Father only. ³⁷As the days of Noah were, so will the coming of the Son of Man be. ³⁸For as in those days which were before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noah entered into the ship, ³⁹and they didn't know until the flood came and took them all away, so will the coming of the Son of Man be. ⁴⁰Then two men will be in the field: one will be taken and one will be left. ⁴¹Two women will be grinding at the mill: one will be taken and one will be left. ⁴²Watch therefore, for you don't know in what hour your Lord comes. ⁴³But know this, that if the master of the house had known in what watch of the night the thief was coming, he would have watched, and would not have allowed his house to be broken into. ⁴⁴Therefore also be ready, for in an hour that you don't expect, the Son of Man will come. ⁴⁵" Who then is the faithful and wise servant, whom his lord has set over his household, to give them their food in due season? ⁴⁶Blessed is that servant whom his lord finds doing so when he comes. ⁴⁷Most certainly I tell you that he will set him over all that he has. ⁴⁸But if that evil servant should say in his heart, 'My lord is delaying his coming,' ⁴⁹and begins to beat his fellow servants, and eat and drink with the drunkards, ⁵⁰the lord of that servant will come in a day when he doesn't expect it and in an hour when he doesn't know it, ⁵¹and will cut him in pieces and appoint his portion with the hypocrites. That is where the weeping and grinding of teeth will be.

25" Then the Kingdom of Heaven will be like ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. ²Five of them were foolish, and five were wise. ³Those who were foolish, when they took their lamps, took no oil with them, ⁴but the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps. ⁵Now while the bridegroom delayed, they all slumbered and slept. ⁶But at midnight there was a cry, 'Behold! The bridegroom is coming! Come out to meet him!' ⁷Then all those virgins arose, and trimmed their lamps. ^{lxxxii} ⁸The foolish said to the wise, 'Give us some

^{lxxx}The word for "generation" (genea) can also be translated as "race."

^{lxxxi}NU adds "nor the son"

^{lxxxii}The end of the wick of an oil lamp needs to be cut off periodically

^{lxxvii}or, oppression

^{lxxviii}or, eagles

^{lxxix}or, oppression

of your oil, for our lamps are going out.’⁹ But the wise answered, saying, ‘What if there isn’t enough for us and you? You go rather to those who sell, and buy for yourselves.’¹⁰ While they went away to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the wedding feast, and the door was shut.¹¹ Afterward the other virgins also came, saying, ‘Lord, Lord, open to us.’¹² But he answered, ‘Most certainly I tell you, I don’t know you.’¹³ Watch therefore, for you don’t know the day nor the hour in which the Son of Man is coming.¹⁴ For it is like a man going into another country, who called his own servants and entrusted his goods to them.¹⁵ To one he gave five talents,^{lxxxiii} to another two, to another one, to each according to his own ability. Then he went on his journey.¹⁶ Immediately he who received the five talents went and traded with them, and made another five talents.¹⁷ In the same way, he also who got the two gained another two.¹⁸ But he who received the one talent went away and dug in the earth and hid his lord’s money.¹⁹ Now after a long time the lord of those servants came, and settled accounts with them.²⁰ He who received the five talents came and brought another five talents, saying, ‘Lord, you delivered to me five talents. Behold, I have gained another five talents in addition to them.’²¹ His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’²² He also who got the two talents came and said, ‘Lord, you delivered to me two talents. Behold, I have gained another two talents in addition to them.’²³ His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things. I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’²⁴ He also who had received the one talent came and said, ‘Lord, I knew you that you are a hard man, reaping where you didn’t sow, and gathering where you didn’t scatter.’²⁵ I was afraid, and went away and hid your talent in the earth. Behold, you have what is yours.’²⁶ But his lord answered him, ‘You wicked and slothful servant. You knew that I reap where I didn’t sow, and gather where I didn’t scatter.’²⁷ You ought therefore to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received back my own with interest.²⁸ Take away therefore the talent from him and give it to him who has the ten talents.²⁹ For to everyone who has will be given, and he will have abundance, but from him who doesn’t have, even that which he has will be taken away.³⁰ Throw out the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’³¹ But when the Son of Man comes in his

glory, and all the holy angels with him, then he will sit on the throne of his glory.³² Before him all the nations will be gathered, and he will separate them one from another, as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats.³³ He will set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left.³⁴ Then the King will tell those on his right hand, ‘Come, blessed of my Father, inherit the Kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world;’³⁵ for I was hungry and you gave me food to eat. I was thirsty and you gave me drink. I was a stranger and you took me in.³⁶ I was naked and you clothed me. I was sick and you visited me. I was in prison and you came to me.’³⁷ Then the righteous will answer him, saying, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and feed you, or thirsty and give you a drink?’³⁸ When did we see you as a stranger and take you in, or naked and clothe you?’³⁹ When did we see you sick or in prison and come to you?’⁴⁰ The King will answer them, ‘Most certainly I tell you, because you did it to one of the least of these my brothers,^{lxxxiv} you did it to me.’⁴¹ Then he will say also to those on the left hand, ‘Depart from me, you cursed, into the eternal fire which is prepared for the devil and his angels;’⁴² for I was hungry, and you didn’t give me food to eat; I was thirsty, and you gave me no drink; ⁴³I was a stranger, and you didn’t take me in; naked, and you didn’t clothe me; sick, and in prison, and you didn’t visit me.’⁴⁴ Then they will also answer, saying, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry, or thirsty, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and didn’t help you?’⁴⁵ Then he will answer them, saying, ‘Most certainly I tell you, because you didn’t do it to one of the least of these, you didn’t do it to me.’⁴⁶ These will go away into eternal punishment, but the righteous into eternal life.”

26 When Yeshua had finished all these words, he said to his disciples,² “You know that after two days the Passover is coming, and the Son of Man will be delivered up to be crucified.”³ Then the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders of the people were gathered together in the court of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas.⁴ They took counsel together that they might take Yeshua by deceit and kill him.⁵ But they said, “Not during the feast, lest a riot occur among the people.”⁶ Now when Yeshua was in Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper,⁷ a woman came to him having an alabaster jar of very expensive ointment, and she poured it on his head as he sat at the table.⁸ But when his disciples saw this, they were indignant, saying, “Why this waste?”⁹ For this ointment might have been sold for much and given to the poor.”¹⁰ However, knowing this, Yeshua said to them, “Why do you trouble the woman? She has done a good work for me.¹¹ For you always have the poor with you, but you don’t always have

to avoid having it become clogged with carbon deposits. The wick height is also adjusted so that the flame burns evenly and gives good light without producing a lot of smoke.

^{lxxxiii} A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds (usually used to weigh silver unless otherwise specified)

^{lxxxiv} The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

me. ¹²For in pouring this ointment on my body, she did it to prepare me for burial. ¹³Most certainly I tell you, wherever this Good News is preached in the whole world, what this woman has done will also be spoken of as a memorial of her.” ¹⁴Then one of the twelve, who was called Judah Iscariot, went to the chief priests ¹⁵and said, “What are you willing to give me if I deliver him to you?” So they weighed out for him thirty pieces of silver. ¹⁶From that time he sought opportunity to betray him. ¹⁷Now on the first day of unleavened bread, the disciples came to Yeshua, saying to him, “Where do you want us to prepare for you to eat the Passover?” ¹⁸He said, “Go into the city to a certain person, and tell him, ‘The Rabbi says, “My time is at hand. I will keep the Passover at your house with my disciples.”’” ¹⁹The disciples did as Yeshua commanded them, and they prepared the Passover. ²⁰Now when evening had come, he was reclining at the table with the twelve disciples. ²¹As they were eating, he said, “Most certainly I tell you that one of you will betray me.” ²²They were exceedingly sorrowful, and each began to ask him, “It isn’t me, is it, Lord?” ²³He answered, “He who dipped his hand with me in the dish will betray me. ²⁴The Son of Man goes even as it is written of him, but woe to that man through whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would be better for that man if he had not been born.” ²⁵Judah, who betrayed him, answered, “It isn’t me, is it, Rabbi?” He said to him, “You said it.” ²⁶As they were eating, Yeshua took bread, gave thanks for ^{lxxxv} it, and broke it. He gave to the disciples and said, “Take, eat; this is my body.” ²⁷He took the cup, gave thanks, and gave to them, saying, “All of you drink it, ²⁸for this is my blood of the new covenant, which is poured out for many for the remission of sins. ²⁹But I tell you that I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on, until that day when I drink it anew with you in my Father’s Kingdom.” ³⁰When they had sung the Hallel, they went out to the Mount of Olives. ³¹Then Yeshua said to them, “All of you will be made to stumble because of me tonight, for it is written, ‘I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’” ³²But after I am raised up, I will go before you into Galilee.” ³³But Peter answered him, “Even if all will be made to stumble because of you, I will never be made to stumble.” ³⁴Yeshua said to him, “Most certainly I tell you that tonight, before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times.” ³⁵Peter said to him, “Even if I must die with you, I will not deny you.” All of the disciples also said likewise. ³⁶Then Yeshua came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to his disciples, “Sit here, while I go there and pray.” ³⁷He took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be sorrowful and severely troubled. ³⁸Then he said to them, “My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with me.” ³⁹He went forward a little, fell on his face, and prayed, say-

ing, “My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass away from me; nevertheless, not what I desire, but what you desire.” ⁴⁰He came to the disciples and found them sleeping, and said to Peter, “What, couldn’t you watch with me for one hour? ⁴¹Watch and pray, that you don’t enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.” ⁴²Again, a second time he went away and prayed, saying, “My Father, if this cup can’t pass away from me unless I drink it, your desire be done.” ⁴³He came again and found them sleeping, for their eyes were heavy. ⁴⁴He left them again, went away, and prayed a third time, saying the same words. ⁴⁵Then he came to his disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners. ⁴⁶Arise, let’s be going. Behold, he who betrays me is at hand.” ⁴⁷While he was still speaking, behold, Judah, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and clubs, from the chief priests and elders of the people. ⁴⁸Now he who betrayed him had given them a sign, saying, “Whoever I kiss, he is the one. Seize him.” ⁴⁹Immediately he came to Yeshua, and said, “Greetings, Rabbi!” and kissed him. ⁵⁰Yeshua said to him, “Friend, why are you here?” Then they came and laid hands on Yeshua, and took him. ⁵¹Behold, one of those who were with Yeshua stretched out his hand and drew his sword, and struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear. ⁵²Then Yeshua said to him, “Put your sword back into its place, for all those who take the sword will die by the sword. ⁵³Or do you think that I couldn’t ask my Father, and he would even now send me more than twelve legions of angels? ⁵⁴How then would the Scriptures be fulfilled that it must be so?” ⁵⁵In that hour Yeshua said to the multitudes, “Have you come out as against a robber with swords and clubs to seize me? I sat daily in the temple teaching, and you didn’t arrest me. ⁵⁶But all this has happened that the Scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled.” Then all the disciples left him and fled. ⁵⁷Those who had taken Yeshua led him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were gathered together. ⁵⁸But Peter followed him from a distance to the court of the high priest, and entered in and sat with the officers, to see the end. ⁵⁹Now the chief priests, the elders, and the whole council sought false testimony against Yeshua, that they might put him to death, ⁶⁰and they found none. Even though many false witnesses came forward, they found none. But at last two false witnesses came forward ⁶¹and said, “This man said, ‘I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.’” ⁶²The high priest stood up and said to him, “Have you no answer? What is this that these testify against you?” ⁶³But Yeshua stayed silent. The high priest answered him, “I adjure you by the living God that you tell us whether you are the Messiah, the Son of God.” ⁶⁴Yeshua said to him, “You have said so. Nevertheless, I tell you, after

^{lxxxv}TR reads “blessed” instead of “gave thanks for”

this you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power, and coming on the clouds of the sky.”⁶⁵ Then the high priest tore his clothing, saying, “He has spoken blasphemy! Why do we need any more witnesses? Behold, now you have heard his blasphemy.”⁶⁶ What do you think?” They answered, “He is worthy of death!”⁶⁷ Then they spat in his face and beat him with their fists, and some slapped him,⁶⁸ saying, “Prophecy to us, you Messiah! Who hit you?”⁶⁹ Now Peter was sitting outside in the court, and a maid came to him, saying, “You were also with Yeshua, the Galilean!”⁷⁰ But he denied it before them all, saying, “I don’t know what you are talking about.”⁷¹ When he had gone out onto the porch, someone else saw him and said to those who were there, “This man also was with Yeshua of Nazareth.”⁷² Again he denied it with an oath, “I don’t know the man.”⁷³ After a little while those who stood by came and said to Peter, “Surely you are also one of them, for your speech makes you known.”⁷⁴ Then he began to curse and to swear, “I don’t know the man!” Immediately the rooster crowed.⁷⁵ Peter remembered the word which Yeshua had said to him, “Before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times.” Then he went out and wept bitterly.

27 Now when morning had come, all the chief priests and the elders of the people took counsel against Yeshua to put him to death.² They bound him, led him away, and delivered him up to Pontius Pilate, the governor.³ Then Judah, who betrayed him, when he saw that Yeshua was condemned, felt remorse, and brought back the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and elders,⁴ saying, “I have sinned in that I betrayed innocent blood.” But they said, “What is that to us? You see to it.”⁵ He threw down the pieces of silver in the sanctuary and departed. Then he went away and hanged himself.⁶ The chief priests took the pieces of silver and said, “It’s not lawful to put them into the treasury, since it is the price of blood.”⁷ They took counsel, and bought the potter’s field with them to bury strangers in.⁸ Therefore that field has been called “The Field of Blood” to this day.⁹ Then that which was spoken through Jeremiah^{lxxxvi} the prophet was fulfilled, saying, “They took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of him upon whom a price had been set, whom some of the children of Israel priced,¹⁰ and they gave them for the potter’s field, as the Lord commanded me.”¹¹ Now Yeshua stood before the governor; and the governor asked him, saying, “Are you the King of the Jews?” Yeshua said to him, “So you say.”¹² When he was accused by the chief priests and elders, he answered nothing.¹³ Then Pilate said to him, “Don’t you hear how many things they testify against you?”¹⁴ He gave him no answer, not even one word, so that the governor marveled greatly.¹⁵ Now at the feast the governor was accustomed to release to the

multitude one prisoner whom they desired.¹⁶ They had then a notable prisoner called Barabbas.¹⁷ When therefore they were gathered together, Pilate said to them, “Whom do you want me to release to you? Barabbas, or Yeshua who is called Messiah?”¹⁸ For he knew that because of envy they had delivered him up.¹⁹ While he was sitting on the judgment seat, his wife sent to him, saying, “Have nothing to do with that righteous man, for I have suffered many things today in a dream because of him.”²⁰ Now the chief priests and the elders persuaded the multitudes to ask for Barabbas and destroy Yeshua.²¹ But the governor answered them, “Which of the two do you want me to release to you?” They said, “Barabbas!”²² Pilate said to them, “What then shall I do to Yeshua who is called Messiah?” They all said to him, “Let him be crucified!”²³ But the governor said, “Why? What evil has he done?” But they cried out exceedingly, saying, “Let him be crucified!”²⁴ So when Pilate saw that nothing was being gained, but rather that a disturbance was starting, he took water and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, “I am innocent of the blood of this righteous person. You see to it.”²⁵ All the people answered, “May his blood be on us and on our children!”²⁶ Then he released Barabbas to them, but Yeshua he flogged and delivered to be crucified.²⁷ Then the governor’s soldiers took Yeshua into the Praetorium, and gathered the whole garrison together against him.²⁸ They stripped him and put a scarlet robe on him.²⁹ They braided a crown of thorns and put it on his head, and a reed in his right hand; and they kneeled down before him and mocked him, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!”³⁰ They spat on him, and took the reed and struck him on the head.³¹ When they had mocked him, they took the robe off him, and put his clothes on him, and led him away to crucify him.³² As they came out, they found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name, and they compelled him to go with them, that he might carry his cross.³³ When they came to a place called “Golgotha”, that is to say, “The place of a skull,”³⁴ they gave him sour wine^{lxxxvii} to drink mixed with gall.^{lxxxviii} When he had tasted it, he would not drink.³⁵ When they had crucified him, they divided his clothing among them, casting lots,^{lxxxix}³⁶ and they sat and watched him there.³⁷ They set up over his head the accusation against him written, “THIS IS YESHUA, THE KING OF THE JEWS.”³⁸ Then there were two robbers crucified with him, one on his right hand and one on the left.³⁹ Those who passed by blasphemed him, wagging their heads⁴⁰ and saying, “You who destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! If you are the Son of God, come down from the cross!”⁴¹ Likewise the chief

^{lxxxvii}or, vinegar

^{lxxxviii}Gall is a bitter-tasting, dark green oil from a wormwood plant that is alcoholic in its effect.

^{lxxxix}TR adds “that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet: ‘They divided my garments among them, and for my clothing they cast lots;’” [see

^{lxxxvi}some manuscripts omit “Jeremiah”

priests also mocking with the scribes, the Pharisees,^{xc} and the elders, said, ⁴²“He saved others, but he can’t save himself. If he is the King of Israel, let him come down from the cross now, and we will believe in him. ⁴³He trusts in God. Let God deliver him now, if he wants him; for he said, ‘I am the Son of God.’” ⁴⁴The robbers also who were crucified with him cast on him the same reproach. ⁴⁵Now from the sixth hour^{xc} there was darkness over all the land until the ninth hour.^{xcii} ⁴⁶About the ninth hour Yeshua cried with a loud voice, saying, “Eli, Eli, lima^{xciii} sabachthani?” That is, “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?” ⁴⁷Some of them who stood there, when they heard it, said, “This man is calling Elijah.” ⁴⁸Immediately one of them ran and took a sponge, filled it with vinegar, put it on a reed, and gave him a drink. ⁴⁹The rest said, “Let him be. Let’s see whether Elijah comes to save him.” ⁵⁰Yeshua cried again with a loud voice, and yielded up his spirit. ⁵¹Behold, the veil of the temple was torn in two from the top to the bottom. The earth quaked and the rocks were split. ⁵²The tombs were opened, and many bodies of the holy ones who had fallen asleep were raised; ⁵³and coming out of the tombs after his resurrection, they entered into the holy city and appeared to many. ⁵⁴Now the centurion and those who were with him watching Yeshua, when they saw the earthquake and the things that were done, were terrified, saying, “Truly this was the Son of God!” ⁵⁵Many women were there watching from afar, who had followed Yeshua from Galilee, serving him. ⁵⁶Among them were Miriam Magdalene, Miriam the mother of Jacob and Yosi, and the mother of the sons of Zebedee. ⁵⁷When evening had come, a rich man from Arimathaea named Joseph, who himself was also Yeshua’s disciple, came. ⁵⁸This man went to Pilate and asked for Yeshua’s body. Then Pilate commanded the body to be given up. ⁵⁹Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth⁶⁰ and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed. ⁶¹Miriam Magdalene was there, and the other Miriam, sitting opposite the tomb. ⁶²Now on the next day, which was the day after the Preparation Day, the chief priests and the Pharisees were gathered together to Pilate, ⁶³saying, “Sir, we remember what that deceiver said while he was still alive: ‘After three days I will rise again.’” ⁶⁴Command therefore that the tomb be made secure until the third day, lest perhaps his disciples come at night and steal him away, and tell the people, ‘He is risen from the dead;’ and the last deception will be worse than the first.” ⁶⁵Pilate said to them, “You have a guard. Go, make it as secure as you can.” ⁶⁶So they went with the guard and made the tomb secure, sealing the stone.

28Now after the Sabbath, as it began to dawn on the first day of the week, Miriam Magdalene and the other Miriam came to see the tomb. ²Behold, there was a great earthquake, for an angel of the Lord descended from the sky and came and rolled away the stone from the door and sat on it. ³His appearance was like lightning, and his clothing white as snow. ⁴For fear of him, the guards shook, and became like dead men. ⁵The angel answered the women, “Don’t be afraid, for I know that you seek Yeshua, who has been crucified. ⁶He is not here, for he has risen, just like he said. Come, see the place where the Lord was lying. ⁷Go quickly and tell his disciples, ‘He has risen from the dead, and behold, he goes before you into Galilee; there you will see him.’ Behold, I have told you.” ⁸They departed quickly from the tomb with fear and great joy, and ran to bring his disciples word. ⁹As they went to tell his disciples, behold, Yeshua met them, saying, “Rejoice!” They came and took hold of his feet, and worshiped him. ¹⁰Then Yeshua said to them, “Don’t be afraid. Go tell my brothers^{xciv} that they should go into Galilee, and there they will see me.” ¹¹Now while they were going, behold, some of the guards came into the city and told the chief priests all the things that had happened. ¹²When they were assembled with the elders and had taken counsel, they gave a large amount of silver to the soldiers, ¹³saying, “Say that his disciples came by night and stole him away while we slept. ¹⁴If this comes to the governor’s ears, we will persuade him and make you free of worry.” ¹⁵So they took the money and did as they were told. This saying was spread abroad among the Judeans, and continues until today. ¹⁶But the eleven disciples went into Galilee, to the mountain where Yeshua had sent them. ¹⁷When they saw him, they bowed down to him; but some doubted. ¹⁸Yeshua came to them and spoke to them, saying, “All authority has been given to me in heaven and on earth. ¹⁹Go^{xcv} and make disciples of all nations, immersing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, ²⁰Amen. teaching them to observe all things that I commanded you. Behold, I am with you always, even to the end of the age.”

^{xc}TR omits “the Pharisees”

^{xc}i noon

^{xcii}3:00 p.m.

^{xciii}TR reads “lama” instead of “lima”

^{xciv}The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

^{xcv}TR and NU add “therefore”

Mark

¹The beginning of the Good News of Yeshua the Messiah, the Son of God. ²As it is written in the Prophets, “Behold, ⁱ I send my messenger before your face, who will prepare your way before you: ³the voice of one crying in the wilderness, ‘Make ready the way of the Lord! Make his paths straight!’” ⁴Yochanan came immersing ⁱⁱ in the wilderness and proclaiming the immersion of repentance for forgiveness of sins. ⁵All the country of Judea and all those of Jerusalem went out to him. They were immersed by him in the Jordan river, confessing their sins. ⁶Yochanan was clothed with camel’s hair and a leather belt around his waist. He ate locusts and wild honey. ⁷He preached, saying, “After me comes he who is mightier than I, the thong of whose sandals I am not worthy to stoop down and loosen. ⁸I immersed you in ⁱⁱⁱ water, but he will immerse you in the Holy Spirit.” ⁹In those days, Yeshua came from Nazareth of Galilee, and was immersed by Yochanan in the Jordan. ¹⁰Immediately coming up from the water, he saw the heavens parting and the Spirit descending on him like a dove. ¹¹A voice came out of the sky, “You are my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.” ¹²Immediately the Spirit drove him out into the wilderness. ¹³He was there in the wilderness forty days, tempted by Satan. He was with the wild animals; and the angels were serving him. ¹⁴Now after Yochanan was taken into custody, Yeshua came into Galilee, proclaiming the Good News of God’s Kingdom, ¹⁵and saying, “The time is fulfilled, and God’s Kingdom is at hand! Repent, and believe in the Good News.” ¹⁶Passing along by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew, the brother of Simon, casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen. ¹⁷Yeshua said to them, “Come after me, and I will make you into fishers for men.” ¹⁸Immediately they left their nets, and followed him. ¹⁹Going on a little further from there, he saw Jacob the son of Zebedee, and Yochanan his brother, who were also in the boat mending the nets. ²⁰Immediately he called them, and they left their father, Zebedee, in the boat with the hired servants, and went after him. ²¹They

went into Capernaum, and immediately on the Sabbath day he entered into the synagogue and taught. ²²They were astonished at his teaching, for he taught them as having authority, and not as the scribes. ²³Immediately there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit, and he cried out, ²⁴saying, “Ha! What do we have to do with you, Yeshua, you Nazarene? Have you come to destroy us? I know you who you are: the Holy One of God!” ²⁵Yeshua rebuked him, saying, “Be quiet, and come out of him!” ²⁶The unclean spirit, convulsing him and crying with a loud voice, came out of him. ²⁷They were all amazed, so that they questioned among themselves, saying, “What is this? A new teaching? For with authority he commands even the unclean spirits, and they obey him!” ²⁸The report of him went out immediately everywhere into all the region of Galilee and its surrounding area. ²⁹Immediately, when they had come out of the synagogue, they came into the house of Simon and Andrew, with Jacob and Yochanan. ³⁰Now Simon’s wife’s mother lay sick with a fever, and immediately they told him about her. ³¹He came and took her by the hand and raised her up. The fever left her immediately, ^{iv} and she served them. ³²At evening, when the sun had set, they brought to him all who were sick and those who were possessed by demons. ³³All the city was gathered together at the door. ³⁴He healed many who were sick with various diseases and cast out many demons. He didn’t allow the demons to speak, because they knew him. ³⁵Early in the morning, while it was still dark, he rose up and went out, and departed into a deserted place, and prayed there. ³⁶Simon and those who were with him searched for him. ³⁷They found him and told him, “Everyone is looking for you.” ³⁸He said to them, “Let’s go elsewhere into the next towns, that I may proclaim there also, because I came out for this reason.” ³⁹He went into their synagogues throughout all Galilee, proclaiming and casting out demons. ⁴⁰A leper came to him, begging him, kneeling down to him, and saying to him, “If you want to, you can make me clean.” ⁴¹Being moved with compassion, he stretched out his hand, and touched him, and said to him, “I want to. Be made clean.” ⁴²When he had said this, immediately the leprosy departed from him and he

ⁱ“Behold”, from “*behold*”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱor, immersing

ⁱⁱⁱThe Greek word (en) translated here as “in” could also be translated as “with” in some contexts.

^{iv}NU omits “immediately”.

was made clean. ⁴³He strictly warned him and immediately sent him out, ⁴⁴and said to him, “ See that you say nothing to anybody, but go show yourself to the priest and offer for your cleansing the things which Moses commanded, for a testimony to them.” ⁴⁵But he went out, and began to proclaim it much, and to spread about the matter, so that Yeshua could no more openly enter into a city, but was outside in desert places. People came to him from everywhere.

2When he entered again into Capernaum after some days, it was heard that he was at home. ²Immediately many were gathered together, so that there was no more room, not even around the door; and he spoke the word to them. ³Four people came, carrying a paralytic to him. ⁴When they could not come near to him for the crowd, they removed the roof where he was. When they had broken it up, they let down the mat that the paralytic was lying on. ⁵Yeshua, seeing their faith, said to the paralytic, “ Son, your sins are forgiven you.” ⁶But there were some of the scribes sitting there and reasoning in their hearts, ⁷“Why does this man speak blasphemies like that? Who can forgive sins but God alone?” ⁸Immediately Yeshua, perceiving in his spirit that they so reasoned within themselves, said to them, “ Why do you reason these things in your hearts? ⁹Which is easier, to tell the paralytic, ‘Your sins are forgiven;’ or to say, ‘Arise, and take up your bed, and walk?’ ¹⁰—But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins” he said to the paralytic— ¹¹“ I tell you, arise, take up your mat, and go to your house.” ¹²He arose, and immediately took up the mat and went out in front of them all, so that they were all amazed and glorified God, saying, “We never saw anything like this!” ¹³He went out again by the seaside. All the multitude came to him, and he taught them. ¹⁴As he passed by, he saw Levi the son of Halfai sitting at the tax office. He said to him, “ Follow me.” And he arose and followed him. ¹⁵He was reclining at the table in his house, and many tax collectors and sinners sat down with Yeshua and his disciples, for there were many, and they followed him. ¹⁶The scribes and the Pharisees, when they saw that he was eating with the sinners and tax collectors, said to his disciples, “Why is it that he eats and drinks with tax collectors and sinners?” ¹⁷When Yeshua heard it, he said to them, “ Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick. I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.” ¹⁸Yochanan’s disciples and the Pharisees were fasting, and they came and asked him, “Why do Yochanan’s disciples and the disciples of the Pharisees fast, but your disciples don’t fast?” ¹⁹Yeshua said to them, “ Can the groomsmen fast while the bridegroom is with them? As long as they have the bridegroom with them, they can’t fast. ²⁰But the days will come when the bridegroom will be taken away from

them, and then they will fast in that day. ²¹No one sews a piece of unshrunk cloth on an old garment, or else the patch shrinks and the new tears away from the old, and a worse hole is made. ²²No one puts new wine into old wineskins; or else the new wine will burst the skins, and the wine pours out, and the skins will be destroyed; but they put new wine into fresh wineskins.” ²³He was going on the Sabbath day through the grain fields; and his disciples began, as they went, to pluck the ears of grain. ²⁴The Pharisees said to him, “Behold, why do they do that which is not lawful on the Sabbath day?” ²⁵He said to them, “ Did you never read what David did when he had need and was hungry—he, and those who were with him? ²⁶How he entered into God’s house at the time of Abiathar the high priest, and ate the show bread, which is not lawful to eat except for the priests, and gave also to those who were with him?” ²⁷He said to them, “ The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath. ²⁸Therefore the Son of Man is lord even of the Sabbath.”

3He entered again into the synagogue, and there was a man there whose hand was withered. ²They watched him, whether he would heal him on the Sabbath day, that they might accuse him. ³He said to the man whose hand was withered, “ Stand up.” ⁴He said to them, “ Is it lawful on the Sabbath day to do good or to do harm? To save a life or to kill?” But they were silent. ⁵When he had looked around at them with anger, being grieved at the hardening of their hearts, he said to the man, “ Stretch out your hand.” He stretched it out, and his hand was restored as healthy as the other. ⁶The Pharisees went out, and immediately conspired with the Herodians against him, how they might destroy him. ⁷Yeshua withdrew to the sea with his disciples; and a great multitude followed him from Galilee, from Judea, ⁸from Jerusalem, from Idumaea, beyond the Jordan, and those from around Tyre and Sidon. A great multitude, hearing what great things he did, came to him. ⁹He spoke to his disciples that a little boat should stay near him because of the crowd, so that they wouldn’t press on him. ¹⁰For he had healed many, so that as many as had diseases pressed on him that they might touch him. ¹¹The unclean spirits, whenever they saw him, fell down before him and cried, “You are the Son of God!” ¹²He sternly warned them that they should not make him known. ¹³He went up into the mountain and called to himself those whom he wanted, and they went to him. ¹⁴He appointed twelve, that they might be with him, and that he might send them out to proclaim ¹⁵and to have authority to heal sicknesses and to cast out demons: ¹⁶Simon (to whom he gave the name Peter); ¹⁷Jacob the son of Zebedee; and Yochanan, the brother of Jacob, (whom he called Benei-Regesh, which means, Sons of Thunder); ¹⁸Andrew; Philip; Bartholomew; Matthew; Thomas; Jacob, the son of Halfai; Taddai; Simon the Zealot; ¹⁹and Judah Iscariot, who also betrayed

him. Then he came into a house. ²⁰The multitude came together again, so that they could not so much as eat bread. ²¹When his friends heard it, they went out to seize him; for they said, “He is insane.” ²²The scribes who came down from Jerusalem said, “He has Beelzebul,” and, “By the prince of the demons he casts out the demons.” ²³He summoned them and said to them in parables, “How can Satan cast out Satan? ²⁴If a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand. ²⁵If a house is divided against itself, that house cannot stand. ²⁶If Satan has risen up against himself, and is divided, he can’t stand, but has an end. ²⁷But no one can enter into the house of the strong man to plunder unless he first binds the strong man; then he will plunder his house. ²⁸“Most certainly I tell you, all sins of the descendants of man will be forgiven, including their blasphemies with which they may blaspheme; ²⁹but whoever may blaspheme against the Holy Spirit never has forgiveness, but is subject to eternal condemnation.” ^v ³⁰—because they said, “He has an unclean spirit.” ³¹His mother and his brothers came, and standing outside, they sent to him, calling him. ³²A multitude was sitting around him, and they told him, “Behold, your mother, your brothers, and your sisters ^{vi} are outside looking for you.” ³³He answered them, “Who are my mother and my brothers?” ³⁴Looking around at those who sat around him, he said, “Behold, my mother and my brothers! ³⁵For whoever does the will of God is my brother, my sister, and mother.”

⁴Again he began to teach by the seaside. A great multitude was gathered to him, so that he entered into a boat in the sea and sat down. All the multitude were on the land by the sea. ²He taught them many things in parables, and told them in his teaching, ³“Listen! Behold, the farmer went out to sow. ⁴As he sowed, some seed fell by the road, and the birds ^{vii} came and devoured it. ⁵Others fell on the rocky ground, where it had little soil, and immediately it sprang up, because it had no depth of soil. ⁶When the sun had risen, it was scorched; and because it had no root, it withered away. ⁷Others fell among the thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked it, and it yielded no fruit. ⁸Others fell into the good ground and yielded fruit, growing up and increasing. Some produced thirty times, some sixty times, and some one hundred times as much.” ⁹He said, “Whoever has ears to hear, let him hear.” ¹⁰When he was alone, those who were around him with the twelve asked him about the parables. ¹¹He said to them, “To you is given the mystery of God’s Kingdom, but to those who are outside, all things are done in parables, ¹²that ‘seeing they may see and not perceive, and hearing they may hear and not understand, lest perhaps they should turn again, and their sins should be forgiven them.’” ¹³He

said to them, “Don’t you understand this parable? How will you understand all of the parables? ¹⁴The farmer sows the word. ¹⁵The ones by the road are the ones where the word is sown; and when they have heard, immediately Satan comes and takes away the word which has been sown in them. ¹⁶These in the same way are those who are sown on the rocky places, who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive it with joy. ¹⁷They have no root in themselves, but are short-lived. When oppression or persecution arises because of the word, immediately they stumble. ¹⁸Others are those who are sown among the thorns. These are those who have heard the word, ¹⁹and the cares of this age, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in choke the word, and it becomes unfruitful. ²⁰Those which were sown on the good ground are those who hear the word, accept it, and bear fruit, some thirty times, some sixty times, and some one hundred times.” ²¹He said to them, “Is a lamp brought to be put under a basket ^{viii} or under a bed? Isn’t it put on a stand? ²²For there is nothing hidden except that it should be made known, neither was anything made secret but that it should come to light. ²³If any man has ears to hear, let him hear.” ²⁴He said to them, “Take heed what you hear. With whatever measure you measure, it will be measured to you; and more will be given to you who hear. ²⁵For whoever has, to him more will be given; and he who doesn’t have, even that which he has will be taken away from him.” ²⁶He said, “God’s Kingdom is as if a man should cast seed on the earth, ²⁷and should sleep and rise night and day, and the seed should spring up and grow, though he doesn’t know how. ²⁸For the earth bears fruit by itself: first the blade, then the ear, then the full grain in the ear. ²⁹But when the fruit is ripe, immediately he puts in the sickle, because the harvest has come.” ³⁰He said, “How will we liken God’s Kingdom? Or with what parable will we illustrate it? ³¹It’s like a grain of mustard seed, which, when it is sown in the earth, though it is less than all the seeds that are on the earth, ³²yet when it is sown, grows up and becomes greater than all the herbs, and puts out great branches, so that the birds of the sky can lodge under its shadow.” ³³With many such parables he spoke the word to them, as they were able to hear it. ³⁴Without a parable he didn’t speak to them; but privately to his own disciples he explained everything. ³⁵On that day, when evening had come, he said to them, “Let’s go over to the other side.” ³⁶Leaving the multitude, they took him with them, even as he was, in the boat. Other small boats were also with him. ³⁷A big wind storm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so much that the boat was already filled. ³⁸He himself was in the stern, asleep on the cushion; and they woke him up and asked him, “Rabbi, don’t you care that we are dying?” ³⁹He awoke and rebuked the wind,

^vNU reads, guilty of an eternal sin.

^{vi}TR omits “your sisters”

^{vii}TR adds “of the air”

^{viii}literally, a modion, a dry measuring basket containing about a peck (about 9 liters)

and said to the sea, "Peace! Be still!" The wind ceased and there was a great calm. ⁴⁰He said to them, "Why are you so afraid? How is it that you have no faith?" ⁴¹They were greatly afraid and said to one another, "Who then is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?"

⁵They came to the other side of the sea, into the country of the Gadarenes. ²When he had come out of the boat, immediately a man with an unclean spirit met him out of the tombs. ³He lived in the tombs. Nobody could bind him any more, not even with chains, ⁴because he had been often bound with fetters and chains, and the chains had been torn apart by him, and the fetters broken in pieces. Nobody had the strength to tame him. ⁵Always, night and day, in the tombs and in the mountains, he was crying out, and cutting himself with stones. ⁶When he saw Yeshua from afar, he ran and bowed down to him, ⁷and crying out with a loud voice, he said, "What have I to do with you, Yeshua, you Son of the Most High God? I adjure you by God, don't torment me." ⁸For he said to him, "Come out of the man, you unclean spirit!" ⁹He asked him, "What is your name?" He said to him, "My name is Legion, for we are many." ¹⁰He begged him much that he would not send them away out of the country. ¹¹Now on the mountainside there was a great herd of pigs feeding. ¹²All the demons begged him, saying, "Send us into the pigs, that we may enter into them." ¹³At once Yeshua gave them permission. The unclean spirits came out and entered into the pigs. The herd of about two thousand rushed down the steep bank into the sea, and they were drowned in the sea. ¹⁴Those who fed the pigs fled, and told it in the city and in the country. The people came to see what it was that had happened. ¹⁵They came to Yeshua, and saw him who had been possessed by demons sitting, clothed, and in his right mind, even him who had the legion; and they were afraid. ¹⁶Those who saw it declared to them what happened to him who was possessed by demons, and about the pigs. ¹⁷They began to beg him to depart from their region. ¹⁸As he was entering into the boat, he who had been possessed by demons begged him that he might be with him. ¹⁹He didn't allow him, but said to him, "Go to your house, to your friends, and tell them what great things the Lord has done for you and how he had mercy on you." ²⁰He went his way, and began to proclaim in Decapolis how Yeshua had done great things for him, and everyone marveled. ²¹When Yeshua had crossed back over in the boat to the other side, a great multitude was gathered to him; and he was by the sea. ²²Behold, one of the rulers of the synagogue, Jairus by name, came; and seeing him, he fell at his feet ²³and begged him much, saying, "My little daughter is at the point of death. Please come and lay your hands on her, that she may be made healthy, and live." ²⁴He went with him, and a great multitude followed him, and they pressed upon him on all

sides. ²⁵A certain woman who had a discharge of blood for twelve years, ²⁶and had suffered many things by many physicians, and had spent all that she had, and was no better, but rather grew worse, ²⁷having heard the things concerning Yeshua, came up behind him in the crowd and touched his clothes. ²⁸For she said, "If I just touch his clothes, I will be made well." ²⁹Immediately the flow of her blood was dried up, and she felt in her body that she was healed of her affliction. ³⁰Immediately Yeshua, perceiving in himself that the power had gone out from him, turned around in the crowd and asked, "Who touched my clothes?" ³¹His disciples said to him, "You see the multitude pressing against you, and you say, 'Who touched me?'" ³²He looked around to see her who had done this thing. ³³But the woman, fearing and trembling, knowing what had been done to her, came and fell down before him, and told him all the truth. ³⁴He said to her, "Daughter, your faith has made you well. Go in peace, and be cured of your disease." ³⁵While he was still speaking, people came from the synagogue ruler's house, saying, "Your daughter is dead. Why bother the Rabbi any more?" ³⁶But Yeshua, when he heard the message spoken, immediately said to the ruler of the synagogue, "Don't be afraid, only believe." ³⁷He allowed no one to follow him except Peter, Jacob, and Yochanan the brother of Jacob. ³⁸He came to the synagogue ruler's house, and he saw an uproar, weeping, and great wailing. ³⁹When he had entered in, he said to them, "Why do you make an uproar and weep? The child is not dead, but is asleep." ⁴⁰They ridiculed him. But he, having put them all out, took the father of the child, her mother, and those who were with him, and went in where the child was lying. ⁴¹Taking the child by the hand, he said to her, "Talitha cumi!" which means, being interpreted, "Girl, I tell you, get up!" ⁴²Immediately the girl rose up and walked, for she was twelve years old. They were amazed with great amazement. ⁴³He strictly ordered them that no one should know this, and commanded that something should be given to her to eat.

⁶He went out from there. He came into his own country, and his disciples followed him. ²When the Sabbath had come, he began to teach in the synagogue, and many hearing him were astonished, saying, "Where did this man get these things?" and, "What is the wisdom that is given to this man, that such mighty works come about by his hands?" ³Isn't this the carpenter, the son of Miriam and brother of Jacob, Yosi, Judah, and Simon? Aren't his sisters here with us?" So they were offended at him. ⁴Yeshua said to them, "A prophet is not without honor, except in his own country, and among his own relatives, and in his own house." ⁵He could do no mighty work there, except that he laid his hands on a few sick people and healed them. ⁶He marveled because of their unbelief. He went around the villages teaching. ⁷He called to himself the twelve, and

began to send them out two by two; and he gave them authority over the unclean spirits. ⁸He commanded them that they should take nothing for their journey, except a staff only: no bread, no wallet, no money in their purse, ⁹but to wear sandals, and not put on two tunics. ¹⁰He said to them, “Wherever you enter into a house, stay there until you depart from there. ¹¹Whoever will not receive you nor hear you, as you depart from there, shake off the dust that is under your feet for a testimony against them. Assuredly, I tell you, it will be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment than for that city!” ¹²They went out and preached that people should repent. ¹³They cast out many demons, and anointed many with oil who were sick and healed them. ¹⁴King Herod heard this, for his name had become known, and he said, “Yochanan the Immerser has risen from the dead, and therefore these powers are at work in him.” ¹⁵But others said, “He is Elijah.” Others said, “He is a prophet, or like one of the prophets.” ¹⁶But Herod, when he heard this, said, “This is Yochanan, whom I beheaded. He has risen from the dead.” ¹⁷For Herod himself had sent out and arrested Yochanan and bound him in prison for the sake of Herodias, his brother Philip’s wife, for he had married her. ¹⁸For Yochanan had said to Herod, “It is not lawful for you to have your brother’s wife.” ¹⁹Herodias set herself against him and desired to kill him, but she couldn’t, ²⁰for Herod feared Yochanan, knowing that he was a righteous and holy man, and kept him safe. When he heard him, he did many things, and he heard him gladly. ²¹Then a convenient day came when Herod on his birthday made a supper for his nobles, the high officers, and the chief men of Galilee. ²²When the daughter of Herodias herself came in and danced, she pleased Herod and those sitting with him. The king said to the young lady, “Ask me whatever you want, and I will give it to you.” ²³He swore to her, “Whatever you ask of me, I will give you, up to half of my kingdom.” ²⁴She went out and said to her mother, “What shall I ask?” She said, “The head of Yochanan the Immerser.” ²⁵She came in immediately with haste to the king and requested, “I want you to give me right now the head of Yochanan the Immerser on a platter.” ²⁶The king was exceedingly sorry, but for the sake of his oaths and of his dinner guests, he didn’t wish to refuse her. ²⁷Immediately the king sent out a soldier of his guard and commanded to bring Yochanan’s head; and he went and beheaded him in the prison, ²⁸and brought his head on a platter, and gave it to the young lady; and the young lady gave it to her mother. ²⁹When his disciples heard this, they came and took up his corpse and laid it in a tomb. ³⁰The emissaries gathered themselves together to Yeshua, and they told him all things, whatever they had done, and whatever they had taught. ³¹He said to them, “Come away into a deserted place, and rest awhile.” For there were many coming and going, and they had no leisure so much as to eat. ³²They

went away in the boat to a deserted place by themselves. ³³They ^{ix}saw them going, and many recognized him and ran there on foot from all the cities. They arrived before them and came together to him. ³⁴Yeshua came out, saw a great multitude, and he had compassion on them because they were like sheep without a shepherd; and he began to teach them many things. ³⁵When it was late in the day, his disciples came to him and said, “This place is deserted, and it is late in the day. ³⁶Send them away, that they may go into the surrounding country and villages and buy themselves bread, for they have nothing to eat.” ³⁷But he answered them, “You give them something to eat.” They asked him, “Shall we go and buy two hundred denarii ^x worth of bread and give them something to eat?” ³⁸He said to them, “How many loaves do you have? Go see.” When they knew, they said, “Five, and two fish.” ³⁹He commanded them that everyone should sit down in groups on the green grass. ⁴⁰They sat down in ranks, by hundreds and by fifties. ⁴¹He took the five loaves and the two fish; and looking up to heaven, he blessed and broke the loaves, and he gave to his disciples to set before them, and he divided the two fish among them all. ⁴²They all ate and were filled. ⁴³They took up twelve baskets full of broken pieces and also of the fish. ⁴⁴Those who ate the loaves were ^{xi}five thousand men. ⁴⁵Immediately he made his disciples get into the boat and go ahead to the other side, to Bethsaida, while he himself sent the multitude away. ⁴⁶After he had taken leave of them, he went up the mountain to pray. ⁴⁷When evening had come, the boat was in the middle of the sea, and he was alone on the land. ⁴⁸Seeing them distressed in rowing, for the wind was contrary to them, about the fourth watch of the night he came to them, walking on the sea; and he would have passed by them, ⁴⁹but they, when they saw him walking on the sea, supposed that it was a ghost, and cried out; ⁵⁰for they all saw him and were troubled. But he immediately spoke with them and said to them, “Cheer up! It is I! ^{xii}Don’t be afraid.” ⁵¹He got into the boat with them; and the wind ceased, and they were very amazed among themselves, and marveled; ⁵²for they hadn’t understood about the loaves, but their hearts were hardened. ⁵³When they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennesaret and moored to the shore. ⁵⁴When they had come out of the boat, immediately the people recognized him, ⁵⁵and ran around that whole region, and began to bring those who were sick on their mats to where they heard he was. ⁵⁶Wherever he entered—into villages, or into cities, or into the country—they laid the sick in the marketplaces and begged him that they might just touch the fringe ^{xiii}of his garment; and as many as touched him

^{ix}TR reads “The multitudes” instead of “They”

^x200 denarii was about 7 or 8 months wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xi}TR adds “about”

^{xii}or, “I AM!”

^{xiii}or, tassel

were made well.

⁷Then the Pharisees and some of the scribes gathered together to him, having come from Jerusalem. ²Now when they saw some of his disciples eating bread with defiled, that is unwashed, hands, they found fault. ³(For the Pharisees and all the Jews don't eat unless they wash their hands and forearms, holding to the tradition of the elders. ⁴They don't eat when they come from the marketplace unless they bathe themselves, and there are many other things which they have received to hold to: washings of cups, pitchers, bronze vessels, and couches.) ⁵The Pharisees and the scribes asked him, "Why don't your disciples walk according to the tradition of the elders, but eat their bread with unwashed hands?" ⁶He answered them, "Well did Isaiah prophesy of you hypocrites, as it is written, 'This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me. ⁷They worship me in vain, teaching as doctrines the commandments of men.' ⁸For you set aside the commandment of God, and hold tightly to the tradition of men—the washing of pitchers and cups, and you do many other such things." ⁹He said to them, "Full well do you reject the commandment of God, that you may keep your tradition. ¹⁰For Moses said, 'Honor your father and your mother;' and, 'He who speaks evil of father or mother, let him be put to death.' ¹¹But you say, 'If a man tells his father or his mother, "Whatever profit you might have received from me is Corban,"' ^{xiv} that is to say, given to God, ¹² then you no longer allow him to do anything for his father or his mother, ¹³making void the word of God by your tradition which you have handed down. You do many things like this." ¹⁴He called all the multitude to himself and said to them, "Hear me, all of you, and understand. ¹⁵There is nothing from outside of the man that going into him can defile him; but the things which proceed out of the man are those that defile the man. ¹⁶If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear!" ^{xv} ¹⁷When he had entered into a house away from the multitude, his disciples asked him about the parable. ¹⁸He said to them, "Are you also without understanding? Don't you perceive that whatever goes into the man from outside can't defile him, ¹⁹because it doesn't go into his heart, but into his stomach, then into the latrine, making all foods clean?" ^{xvi} ²⁰He said, "That which proceeds out of the man, that defiles the man. ²¹For from within, out of the hearts of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, sexual sins, murders, thefts, ²²covetings, wickedness, deceit, lustful desires, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, and foolishness. ²³All these evil things come from within and defile the man." ²⁴From there he arose and went away into the borders of Tyre and Sidon.

He entered into a house and didn't want anyone to know it, but he couldn't escape notice. ²⁵For a woman whose little daughter had an unclean spirit, having heard of him, came and fell down at his feet. ²⁶Now the woman was a Greek, a Syrophoenician by race. She begged him that he would cast the demon out of her daughter. ²⁷But Yeshua said to her, "Let the children be filled first, for it is not appropriate to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs." ²⁸But she answered him, "Yes, Lord. Yet even the dogs under the table eat the children's crumbs." ²⁹He said to her, "For this saying, go your way. The demon has gone out of your daughter." ³⁰She went away to her house, and found the child having been laid on the bed, with the demon gone out. ³¹Again he departed from the borders of Tyre and Sidon, and came to the sea of Galilee through the middle of the region of Decapolis. ³²They brought to him one who was deaf and had an impediment in his speech. They begged him to lay his hand on him. ³³He took him aside from the multitude privately and put his fingers into his ears; and he spat and touched his tongue. ³⁴Looking up to heaven, he sighed, and said to him, "Ephphatha!" that is, "Be opened!" ³⁵Immediately his ears were opened, and the impediment of his tongue was released, and he spoke clearly. ³⁶He commanded them that they should tell no one, but the more he commanded them, so much the more widely they proclaimed it. ³⁷They were astonished beyond measure, saying, "He has done all things well. He makes even the deaf hear and the mute speak!"

⁸In those days, when there was a very great multitude, and they had nothing to eat, Yeshua called his disciples to himself and said to them, ²"I have compassion on the multitude, because they have stayed with me now three days and have nothing to eat. ³If I send them away fasting to their home, they will faint on the way, for some of them have come a long way." ⁴His disciples answered him, "From where could one satisfy these people with bread here in a deserted place?" ⁵He asked them, "How many loaves do you have?" They said, "Seven." ⁶He commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground, and he took the seven loaves. Having given thanks, he broke them and gave them to his disciples to serve, and they served the multitude. ⁷They also had a few small fish. Having blessed them, he said to serve these also. ⁸They ate and were filled. They took up seven baskets of broken pieces that were left over. ⁹Those who had eaten were about four thousand. Then he sent them away. ¹⁰Immediately he entered into the boat with his disciples and came into the region of Dalmanutha. ¹¹The Pharisees came out and began to question him, seeking from him a sign from heaven and testing him. ¹²He sighed deeply in his spirit and said, "Why does this generation ^{xvii} seek a sign? Most certainly I tell you, no sign

^{xiv}Corban is a Hebrew word for an offering devoted to God.

^{xv}NU omits verse 16.

^{xvi}NU ends Yeshua's direct quote and question after "latrine", ending the verse with "Thus he declared all foods clean."

^{xvii}The word translated "generation" here (genea) could also be translated "people", "race", or "family".

will be given to this generation.” ¹³He left them, and again entering into the boat, departed to the other side. ¹⁴They forgot to take bread; and they didn’t have more than one loaf in the boat with them. ¹⁵He warned them, saying, “Take heed: beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and the yeast of Herod.” ¹⁶They reasoned with one another, saying, “It’s because we have no bread.” ¹⁷Yeshua, perceiving it, said to them, “Why do you reason that it’s because you have no bread? Don’t you perceive yet or understand? Is your heart still hardened?” ¹⁸Having eyes, don’t you see? Having ears, don’t you hear? Don’t you remember? ¹⁹When I broke the five loaves among the five thousand, how many baskets full of broken pieces did you take up?” They told him, “Twelve.” ²⁰“When the seven loaves fed the four thousand, how many baskets full of broken pieces did you take up?” They told him, “Seven.” ²¹He asked them, “Don’t you understand yet?” ²²He came to Bethsaida. They brought a blind man to him and begged him to touch him. ²³He took hold of the blind man by the hand, and brought him out of the village. When he had spat on his eyes, and laid his hands on him, he asked him if he saw anything. ²⁴He looked up, and said, “I see men, but I see them like walking trees.” ²⁵Then again he laid his hands on his eyes. He looked intently, and was restored, and saw everyone clearly. ²⁶He sent him away to his house, saying, “Don’t enter into the village, nor tell anyone in the village.” ²⁷Yeshua went out, with his disciples, into the villages of Caesarea Philippi. On the way he asked his disciples, “Who do men say that I am?” ²⁸They told him, “Yochanan the Immerser, and others say Elijah, but others, one of the prophets.” ²⁹He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered, “You are the Messiah.” ³⁰He commanded them that they should tell no one about him. ³¹He began to teach them that the Son of Man must suffer many things, and be rejected by the elders, the chief priests, and the scribes, and be killed, and after three days rise again. ³²He spoke to them openly. Peter took him and began to rebuke him. ³³But he, turning around and seeing his disciples, rebuked Peter, and said, “Get behind me, Satan! For you have in mind not the things of God, but the things of men.” ³⁴He called the multitude to himself with his disciples and said to them, “Whoever wants to come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me. ³⁵For whoever wants to save his life will lose it; and whoever will lose his life for my sake and the sake of the Good News will save it. ³⁶For what does it profit a man to gain the whole world and forfeit his life? ³⁷For what will a man give in exchange for his life? ³⁸For whoever will be ashamed of me and of my words in this adulterous and sinful generation, the Son of Man also will be ashamed of him when he comes in his Father’s glory with the holy angels.”

⁹He said to them, “Most certainly I tell you, there are

some standing here who will in no way taste death until they see God’s Kingdom come with power.” ²After six days Yeshua took with him Peter, Jacob, and Yochanan, and brought them up onto a high mountain privately by themselves, and he was changed into another form in front of them. ³His clothing became glistening, exceedingly white, like snow, such as no launderer on earth can whiten them. ⁴Elijah and Moses appeared to them, and they were talking with Yeshua. ⁵Peter answered Yeshua, “Rabbi, it is good for us to be here. Let’s make three tents: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.” ⁶For he didn’t know what to say, for they were very afraid. ⁷A cloud came, overshadowing them, and a voice came out of the cloud, “This is my beloved Son. Listen to him.” ⁸Suddenly looking around, they saw no one with them any more, except Yeshua only. ⁹As they were coming down from the mountain, he commanded them that they should tell no one what things they had seen, until after the Son of Man had risen from the dead. ¹⁰They kept this saying to themselves, questioning what the “rising from the dead” meant. ¹¹They asked him, saying, “Why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?” ¹²He said to them, “Elijah indeed comes first, and restores all things. How is it written about the Son of Man, that he should suffer many things and be despised? ¹³But I tell you that Elijah has come, and they have also done to him whatever they wanted to, even as it is written about him.” ¹⁴Coming to the disciples, he saw a great multitude around them, and scribes questioning them. ¹⁵Immediately all the multitude, when they saw him, were greatly amazed, and running to him, greeted him. ¹⁶He asked the scribes, “What are you asking them?” ¹⁷One of the multitude answered, “Rabbi, I brought to you my son, who has a mute spirit; ¹⁸and wherever it seizes him, it throws him down; and he foams at the mouth, grinds his teeth, and becomes rigid. I asked your disciples to cast it out, and they weren’t able.” ¹⁹He answered him, “Unbelieving generation, how long shall I be with you? How long shall I bear with you? Bring him to me.” ²⁰They brought him to him, and when he saw him, immediately the spirit convulsed him and he fell on the ground, wallowing and foaming at the mouth. ²¹He asked his father, “How long has it been since this has been happening to him?” He said, “From childhood. ²²Often it has cast him both into the fire and into the water to destroy him. But if you can do anything, have compassion on us and help us.” ²³Yeshua said to him, “If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes.” ²⁴Immediately the father of the child cried out with tears, “I believe. Help my unbelief!” ²⁵When Yeshua saw that a multitude came running together, he rebuked the unclean spirit, saying to him, “You mute and deaf spirit, I command you, come out of him, and never enter him again!” ²⁶After crying out and convulsing him greatly, it came out of him. The boy became like one dead, so much that most of them said, “He

is dead.” ²⁷But Yeshua took him by the hand and raised him up; and he arose. ²⁸When he had come into the house, his disciples asked him privately, “Why couldn’t we cast it out?” ²⁹He said to them, “This kind can come out by nothing but by prayer and fasting.” ³⁰They went out from there and passed through Galilee. He didn’t want anyone to know it, ³¹for he was teaching his disciples, and said to them, “The Son of Man is being handed over to the hands of men, and they will kill him; and when he is killed, on the third day he will rise again.” ³²But they didn’t understand the saying, and were afraid to ask him. ³³He came to Capernaum, and when he was in the house he asked them, “What were you arguing among yourselves on the way?” ³⁴But they were silent, for they had disputed with one another on the way about who was the greatest. ³⁵He sat down and called the twelve; and he said to them, “If any man wants to be first, he shall be last of all, and servant of all.” ³⁶He took a little child and set him in the middle of them. Taking him in his arms, he said to them, ³⁷“Whoever receives one such little child in my name receives me; and whoever receives me, doesn’t receive me, but him who sent me.” ³⁸Yochanan said to him, “Rabbi, we saw someone who doesn’t follow us casting out demons in your name; and we forbade him, because he doesn’t follow us.” ³⁹But Yeshua said, “Don’t forbid him, for there is no one who will do a mighty work in my name and be able quickly to speak evil of me. ⁴⁰For whoever is not against us is on our side. ⁴¹For whoever will give you a cup of water to drink in my name because you are Messiah’s, most certainly I tell you, he will in no way lose his reward. ⁴²“Whoever will cause one of these little ones who believe in me to stumble, it would be better for him if he were thrown into the sea with a millstone hung around his neck. ⁴³If your hand causes you to stumble, cut it off. It is better for you to enter into life maimed, rather than having your two hands to go into Gehinnom, ^{xviii} into the unquenchable fire, ⁴⁴‘where their worm doesn’t die, and the fire is not quenched.’ ^{xix} ⁴⁵If your foot causes you to stumble, cut it off. It is better for you to enter into life lame, rather than having your two feet to be cast into Gehinnom, ^{xx} into the fire that will never be quenched— ⁴⁶‘where their worm doesn’t die, and the fire is not quenched.’ ^{xxi} ⁴⁷If your eye causes you to stumble, throw it out. It is better for you to enter into God’s Kingdom with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into the Gehinnom ^{xxii} of fire, ⁴⁸‘where their worm doesn’t die, and the fire is not quenched.’ ⁴⁹For everyone will be salted with fire, and every sacrifice will be seasoned with salt. ⁵⁰Salt is good, but if the salt has lost its saltiness, with what will you sea-

son it? Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with one another.”

¹⁰He arose from there and came into the borders of Judea and beyond the Jordan. Multitudes came together to him again. As he usually did, he was again teaching them. ²Pharisees came to him testing him, and asked him, “Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife?” ³He answered, “What did Moses command you?” ⁴They said, “Moses allowed a certificate of divorce to be written, and to divorce her.” ⁵But Yeshua said to them, “For your hardness of heart, he wrote you this commandment. ⁶But from the beginning of the creation, God made them male and female. ⁷For this cause a man will leave his father and mother, and will join to his wife, ⁸and the two will become one flesh, so that they are no longer two, but one flesh. ⁹What therefore God has joined together, let no man separate.” ¹⁰In the house, his disciples asked him again about the same matter. ¹¹He said to them, “Whoever divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery against her. ¹²If a woman herself divorces her husband and marries another, she commits adultery.” ¹³They were bringing to him little children, that he should touch them, but the disciples rebuked those who were bringing them. ¹⁴But when Yeshua saw it, he was moved with indignation and said to them, “Allow the little children to come to me! Don’t forbid them, for God’s Kingdom belongs to such as these. ¹⁵Most certainly I tell you, whoever will not receive God’s Kingdom like a little child, he will in no way enter into it.” ¹⁶He took them in his arms and blessed them, laying his hands on them. ¹⁷As he was going out into the way, one ran to him, knelt before him, and asked him, “Good Rabbi, what shall I do that I may inherit eternal life?” ¹⁸Yeshua said to him, “Why do you call me good? No one is good except one—God. ¹⁹You know the commandments: ‘Do not murder,’ ‘Do not commit adultery,’ ‘Do not steal,’ ‘Do not give false testimony,’ ‘Do not defraud,’ ‘Honor your father and mother.’” ²⁰He said to him, “Rabbi, I have observed all these things from my youth.” ²¹Yeshua looking at him loved him, and said to him, “One thing you lack. Go, sell whatever you have and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me, taking up the cross.” ²²But his face fell at that saying, and he went away sorrowful, for he was one who had great possessions. ²³Yeshua looked around and said to his disciples, “How difficult it is for those who have riches to enter into God’s Kingdom!” ²⁴The disciples were amazed at his words. But Yeshua answered again, “Children, how hard it is for those who trust in riches to enter into God’s Kingdom! ²⁵It is easier for a camel to go through a needle’s eye than for a rich man to enter into God’s Kingdom.” ²⁶They were exceedingly astonished, saying to him, “Then who can be saved?” ²⁷Yeshua, looking at them, said, “With men it is impossible, but not with God, for all things are possible

^{xviii}or, Hell

^{xix}NU omits verse 44.

^{xx}or, Hell

^{xxi}NU omits verse 46.

^{xxii}or, Hell

with God.” ²⁸Peter began to tell him, “Behold, we have left all and have followed you.” ²⁹Yeshua said, “Most certainly I tell you, there is no one who has left house, or brothers, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or land, for my sake, and for the sake of the Good News, ³⁰but he will receive one hundred times more now in this time: houses, brothers, sisters, mothers, children, and land, with persecutions; and in the age to come eternal life. ³¹But many who are first will be last, and the last first.” ³²They were on the way, going up to Jerusalem; and Yeshua was going in front of them, and they were amazed; and those who followed were afraid. He again took the twelve, and began to tell them the things that were going to happen to him. ³³“Behold, we are going up to Jerusalem. The Son of Man will be delivered to the chief priests and the scribes. They will condemn him to death, and will deliver him to the Gentiles. ³⁴They will mock him, spit on him, scourge him, and kill him. On the third day he will rise again.” ³⁵Jacob and Yochanan, the sons of Zebedee, came near to him, saying, “Rabbi, we want you to do for us whatever we will ask.” ³⁶He said to them, “What do you want me to do for you?” ³⁷They said to him, “Grant to us that we may sit, one at your right hand and one at your left hand, in your glory.” ³⁸But Yeshua said to them, “You don’t know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I drink, and to be immersed with the immersion that I am immersed with?” ³⁹They said to him, “We are able.” Yeshua said to them, “You shall indeed drink the cup that I drink, and you shall be immersed with the immersion that I am immersed with; ⁴⁰but to sit at my right hand and at my left hand is not mine to give, but for whom it has been prepared.” ⁴¹When the ten heard it, they began to be indignant toward Jacob and Yochanan. ⁴²Yeshua summoned them and said to them, “You know that they who are recognized as rulers over the nations lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them. ⁴³But it shall not be so among you, but whoever wants to become great among you shall be your servant. ⁴⁴Whoever of you wants to become first among you shall be bondservant of all. ⁴⁵For the Son of Man also came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.” ⁴⁶They came to Jericho. As he went out from Jericho with his disciples and a great multitude, the son of Timaeus, Bartimaeus, a blind beggar, was sitting by the road. ⁴⁷When he heard that it was Yeshua the Nazarene, he began to cry out and say, “Yeshua, you son of David, have mercy on me!” ⁴⁸Many rebuked him, that he should be quiet, but he cried out much more, “You son of David, have mercy on me!” ⁴⁹Yeshua stood still and said, “Call him.” They called the blind man, saying to him, “Cheer up! Get up. He is calling you!” ⁵⁰He, casting away his cloak, sprang up, and came to Yeshua. ⁵¹Yeshua asked him, “What do you want me to do for you?” The blind man said

to him, “Rabboni, ^{xxiii} that I may see again.” ⁵²Yeshua said to him, “Go your way. Your faith has made you well.” Immediately he received his sight and followed Yeshua on the way.

11 When they came near to Jerusalem, to Bethsphage ^{xxiv} and Bethany, at the Mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples ²and said to them, “Go your way into the village that is opposite you. Immediately as you enter into it, you will find a young donkey tied, on which no one has sat. Untie him and bring him. ³If anyone asks you, ‘Why are you doing this?’ say, ‘The Lord needs him;’ and immediately he will send him back here.” ⁴They went away, and found a young donkey tied at the door outside in the open street, and they untied him. ⁵Some of those who stood there asked them, “What are you doing, untying the young donkey?” ⁶They said to them just as Yeshua had said, and they let them go. ⁷They brought the young donkey to Yeshua and threw their garments on it, and Yeshua sat on it. ⁸Many spread their garments on the way, and others were cutting down branches from the trees and spreading them on the road. ⁹Those who went in front and those who followed cried out, “Hoshia’na! ^{xxv} Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! ¹⁰Blessed is the kingdom of our father David that is coming in the name of the Lord! Hoshia’na in the highest!” ¹¹Yeshua entered into the temple in Jerusalem. When he had looked around at everything, it being now evening, he went out to Bethany with the twelve. ¹²The next day, when they had come out from Bethany, he was hungry. ¹³Seeing a fig tree afar off having leaves, he came to see if perhaps he might find anything on it. When he came to it, he found nothing but leaves, for it was not the season for figs. ¹⁴Yeshua told it, “May no one ever eat fruit from you again!” and his disciples heard it. ¹⁵They came to Jerusalem, and Yeshua entered into the temple and began to throw out those who sold and those who bought in the temple, and overthrew the money changers’ tables and the seats of those who sold the doves. ¹⁶He would not allow anyone to carry a container through the temple. ¹⁷He taught, saying to them, “Isn’t it written, ‘My house will be called a house of prayer for all the nations?’ But you have made it a den of robbers!” ¹⁸The chief priests and the scribes heard it, and sought how they might destroy him. For they feared him, because all the multitude was astonished at his teaching. ¹⁹When evening came, he went out of the city. ²⁰As they passed by in the morning, they saw the fig tree withered away from the roots. ²¹Peter, remembering, said to him, “Rabbi, look! The fig tree which you cursed has withered away.” ²²Yeshua answered them,

^{xxiii}Rabboni is a transliteration of the Hebrew word for “great teacher.”

^{xxiv}TR & NU read “Bethphage” instead of “Bethsphage”

^{xxv}“Hoshia’na” means “save us” or “help us, we pray”.

“Have faith in God. ²³For most certainly I tell you, whoever may tell this mountain, ‘Be taken up and cast into the sea,’ and doesn’t doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says is happening, he shall have whatever he says. ²⁴Therefore I tell you, all things whatever you pray and ask for, believe that you have received them, and you shall have them. ²⁵Whenever you stand praying, forgive, if you have anything against anyone; so that your Father, who is in heaven, may also forgive you your transgressions. ²⁶But if you do not forgive, neither will your Father in heaven forgive your transgressions.” ^{xxvi} ²⁷They came again to Jerusalem, and as he was walking in the temple, the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders came to him, ²⁸and they began saying to him, “By what authority do you do these things? Or who gave you this authority to do these things?” ²⁹Yeshua said to them, “I will ask you one question. Answer me, and I will tell you by what authority I do these things. ³⁰The immersion of Yochanan—was it from heaven, or from men? Answer me.” ³¹They reasoned with themselves, saying, “If we should say, ‘From heaven;’ he will say, ‘Why then did you not believe him?’ ³²If we should say, ‘From men’—they feared the people, for all held Yochanan to really be a prophet. ³³They answered Yeshua, “We don’t know.” Yeshua said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.”

12He began to speak to them in parables. “A man planted a vineyard, put a hedge around it, dug a pit for the wine press, built a tower, rented it out to a farmer, and went into another country. ²When it was time, he sent a servant to the farmer to get from the farmer his share of the fruit of the vineyard. ³They took him, beat him, and sent him away empty. ⁴Again, he sent another servant to them; and they threw stones at him, wounded him in the head, and sent him away shamefully treated. ⁵Again he sent another, and they killed him, and many others, beating some, and killing some. ⁶Therefore still having one, his beloved son, he sent him last to them, saying, ‘They will respect my son.’ ⁷But those farmers said among themselves, ‘This is the heir. Come, let’s kill him, and the inheritance will be ours.’ ⁸They took him, killed him, and cast him out of the vineyard. ⁹What therefore will the lord of the vineyard do? He will come and destroy the farmers, and will give the vineyard to others. ¹⁰Haven’t you even read this Scripture: ‘The stone which the builders rejected was made the head of the corner. ¹¹This was from the Lord. It is marvelous in our eyes?’” ¹²They tried to seize him, but they feared the multitude; for they perceived that he spoke the parable against them. They left him and went away. ¹³They sent some of the Pharisees and the Herodians to him, that they might trap him with words. ¹⁴When they had come, they asked him, “Rabbi, we know that you are honest, and don’t defer to anyone; for you aren’t partial

to anyone, but truly teach the way of God. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar, or not? ¹⁵Shall we give, or shall we not give?” But he, knowing their hypocrisy, said to them, “Why do you test me? Bring me a denarius, that I may see it.” ¹⁶They brought it. He said to them, “Whose is this image and inscription?” They said to him, “Caesar’s.” ¹⁷Yeshua answered them, “Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s.” They marveled greatly at him. ¹⁸Some Sadducees, who say that there is no resurrection, came to him. They asked him, saying, ¹⁹“Rabbi, Moses wrote to us, ‘If a man’s brother dies and leaves a wife behind him, and leaves no children, that his brother should take his wife and raise up offspring for his brother.’ ²⁰There were seven brothers. The first took a wife, and dying left no offspring. ²¹The second took her, and died, leaving no children behind him. The third likewise; ²²and the seven took her and left no children. Last of all the woman also died. ²³In the resurrection, when they rise, whose wife will she be of them? For the seven had her as a wife.” ²⁴Yeshua answered them, “Isn’t this because you are mistaken, not knowing the Scriptures nor the power of God? ²⁵For when they will rise from the dead, they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are like angels in heaven. ²⁶But about the dead, that they are raised, haven’t you read in the book of Moses about the Bush, how God spoke to him, saying, ‘I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob’? ²⁷He is not the God of the dead, but of the living. You are therefore badly mistaken.” ²⁸One of the scribes came and heard them questioning together, and knowing that he had answered them well, asked him, “Which commandment is the greatest of all?” ²⁹Yeshua answered, “The greatest is: ‘Hear, Israel, the Lord our God, the Lord is one. ³⁰You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your mind, and with all your strength.’ This is the first commandment. ³¹The second is like this: ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’ There is no other commandment greater than these.” ³²The scribe said to him, “Truly, Rabbi, you have said well that he is one, and there is none other but he; ³³and to love him with all the heart, with all the understanding, all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbor as himself, is more important than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.” ³⁴When Yeshua saw that he answered wisely, he said to him, “You are not far from God’s Kingdom.” No one dared ask him any question after that. ³⁵Yeshua responded, as he taught in the temple, “How is it that the scribes say that the Messiah is the son of David? ³⁶For David himself said in the Holy Spirit, ‘The Lord said to my Lord, “Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies the footstool of your feet.”’ ³⁷Therefore David himself calls him Lord, so how can he be his son?” The common people heard him gladly. ³⁸In his teaching he said to them, “Beware of the scribes, who like to walk

^{xxvi}NU omits verse 26.

in long robes, and to get greetings in the marketplaces,³⁹ and to get the best seats in the synagogues and the best places at feasts,⁴⁰ those who devour widows' houses, and for a pretense make long prayers. These will receive greater condemnation." ⁴¹Yeshua sat down opposite the treasury and saw how the multitude cast money into the treasury. Many who were rich cast in much. ⁴²A poor widow came and she cast in two small brass coins, ^{xxvii} which equal a quadrans coin. ^{xxviii} ⁴³He called his disciples to himself and said to them, "Most certainly I tell you, this poor widow gave more than all those who are giving into the treasury, ⁴⁴for they all gave out of their abundance, but she, out of her poverty, gave all that she had to live on."

13As he went out of the temple, one of his disciples said to him, "Rabbi, see what kind of stones and what kind of buildings!" ²Yeshua said to him, "Do you see these great buildings? There will not be left here one stone on another, which will not be thrown down." ³As he sat on the Mount of Olives opposite the temple, Peter, Jacob, Yochanan, and Andrew asked him privately, ⁴"Tell us, when will these things be? What is the sign that these things are all about to be fulfilled?" ⁵Yeshua, answering, began to tell them, "Be careful that no one leads you astray. ⁶For many will come in my name, saying, 'I am he!' ^{xxix} and will lead many astray. ⁷"When you hear of wars and rumors of wars, don't be troubled. For those must happen, but the end is not yet. ⁸For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be earthquakes in various places. There will be famines and troubles. These things are the beginning of birth pains. ⁹"But watch yourselves, for they will deliver you up to councils. You will be beaten in synagogues. You will stand before rulers and kings for my sake, for a testimony to them. ¹⁰The Good News must first be preached to all the nations. ¹¹When they lead you away and deliver you up, don't be anxious beforehand or premeditate what you will say, but say whatever will be given you in that hour. For it is not you who speak, but the Holy Spirit. ¹²"Brother will deliver up brother to death, and the father his child. Children will rise up against parents and cause them to be put to death. ¹³You will be hated by all men for my name's sake, but he who endures to the end will be saved. ¹⁴"But when you see the abomination of desolation, spoken (let of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not" the reader understand), "then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains, ¹⁵and let him who is on the housetop not go down, nor enter in, to take any-

^{xxvii}literally, lepta (or widow's mites). Lepta are very small brass coins worth half a quadrans each, which is a quarter of the copper assarion. Lepta are worth less than 1% of an agricultural worker's daily wages.

^{xxviii}A quadrans is a coin worth about 1/64 of a denarius. A denarius is about one day's wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xxix}or, "I AM!"

thing out of his house. ¹⁶Let him who is in the field not return back to take his cloak. ¹⁷But woe to those who are with child and to those who nurse babies in those days! ¹⁸Pray that your flight won't be in the winter. ¹⁹For in those days there will be oppression, such as there has not been the like from the beginning of the creation which God created until now, and never will be. ²⁰Unless the Lord had shortened the days, no flesh would have been saved; but for the sake of the chosen ones, whom he picked out, he shortened the days. ²¹Then if anyone tells you, 'Look, here is the Messiah!' or, 'Look, there!' don't believe it. ²²For false messiahs and false prophets will arise and will show signs and wonders, that they may lead astray, if possible, even the chosen ones. ²³But you watch."Behold, I have told you all things beforehand. ²⁴But in those days, after that oppression, the sun will be darkened, the moon will not give its light, ²⁵the stars will be falling from the sky, and the powers that are in the heavens will be shaken. ²⁶Then they will see the Son of Man coming in clouds with great power and glory. ²⁷Then he will send out his angels, and will gather together his chosen ones from the four winds, from the ends of the earth to the ends of the sky. ²⁸"Now from the fig tree, learn this parable. When the branch has now become tender and produces its leaves, you know that the summer is near; ²⁹even so you also, when you see these things coming to pass, know that it is near, at the doors. ³⁰Most certainly I say to you, this generation ^{xxx} will not pass away until all these things happen. ³¹Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away. ³²"But of that day or that hour no one knows—not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father. ³³Watch, keep alert, and pray; for you don't know when the time is. ³⁴"It is like a man traveling to another country, having left his house and given authority to his servants, and to each one his work, and also commanded the doorkeeper to keep watch. ³⁵Watch therefore, for you don't know when the lord of the house is coming—whether at evening, or at midnight, or when the rooster crows, or in the morning; ³⁶lest, coming suddenly, he might find you sleeping. ³⁷What I tell you, I tell all: Watch!"

14It was now two days before the Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread, and the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might seize him by deception and kill him. ²For they said, "Not during the feast, because there might be a riot among the people." ³While he was at Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper, as he sat at the table, a woman came having an alabaster jar of ointment of pure nard—very costly. She broke the jar and poured it over his head. ⁴But there were some who were indignant among themselves, saying, "Why has this ointment been

^{xxx}The word translated "generation" (genea) could also be translated "race", "family", or "people".

wasted? ⁵For this might have been sold for more than three hundred denarii ^{xxxi} and given to the poor.” So they grumbled against her. ⁶But Yeshua said, “Leave her alone. Why do you trouble her? She has done a good work for me. ⁷For you always have the poor with you, and whenever you want to, you can do them good; but you will not always have me. ⁸She has done what she could. She has anointed my body beforehand for the burying. ⁹Most certainly I tell you, wherever this Good News may be preached throughout the whole world, that which this woman has done will also be spoken of for a memorial of her.” ¹⁰Judah Iscariot, who was one of the twelve, went away to the chief priests, that he might deliver him to them. ¹¹They, when they heard it, were glad, and promised to give him money. He sought how he might conveniently deliver him. ¹²On the first day of unleavened bread, when they sacrificed the Passover, his disciples asked him, “Where do you want us to go and prepare that you may eat the Passover?” ¹³He sent two of his disciples and said to them, “Go into the city, and there a man carrying a pitcher of water will meet you. Follow him, ¹⁴and wherever he enters in, tell the master of the house, ‘The Rabbi says, “Where is the guest room, where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?”’ ¹⁵He will himself show you a large upper room furnished and ready. Get ready for us there.” ¹⁶His disciples went out, and came into the city, and found things as he had said to them, and they prepared the Passover. ¹⁷When it was evening he came with the twelve. ¹⁸As they sat and were eating, Yeshua said, “Most certainly I tell you, one of you will betray me—he who eats with me.” ¹⁹They began to be sorrowful, and to ask him one by one, “Surely not I?” And another said, “Surely not I?” ²⁰He answered them, “It is one of the twelve, he who dips with me in the dish. ²¹For the Son of Man goes as it is written about him, but woe to that man by whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would be better for that man if he had not been born.” ²²As they were eating, Yeshua took bread, and when he had blessed it, he broke it and gave to them, and said, “Take, eat. This is my body.” ²³He took the cup, and when he had given thanks, he gave to them. They all drank of it. ²⁴He said to them, “This is my blood of the new covenant, which is poured out for many. ²⁵Most certainly I tell you, I will no more drink of the fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it anew in God’s Kingdom.” ²⁶When they had sung the Hallel, they went out to the Mount of Olives. ²⁷Yeshua said to them, “All of you will be made to stumble because of me tonight, for it is written, ‘I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered.’ ²⁸However, after I am raised up, I will go before you into Galilee.” ²⁹But Peter said to him, “Although all will be offended, yet I will not.” ³⁰Yeshua said to him, “Most certainly I tell you that you today, even this night, before the rooster crows twice, you will deny me three times.” ³¹But he spoke all the more,

“If I must die with you, I will not deny you.” They all said the same thing. ³²They came to a place which was named Gethsemane. He said to his disciples, “Sit here while I pray.” ³³He took with him Peter, Jacob, and Yochanan, and began to be greatly troubled and distressed. ³⁴He said to them, “My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch.” ³⁵He went forward a little, and fell on the ground, and prayed that if it were possible, the hour might pass away from him. ³⁶He said, “Abba, ^{xxxii} Father, all things are possible to you. Please remove this cup from me. However, not what I desire, but what you desire.” ³⁷He came and found them sleeping, and said to Peter, “Simon, are you sleeping? Couldn’t you watch one hour? ³⁸Watch and pray, that you may not enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.” ³⁹Again he went away and prayed, saying the same words. ⁴⁰Again he returned and found them sleeping, for their eyes were very heavy; and they didn’t know what to answer him. ⁴¹He came the third time and said to them, “Sleep on now, and take your rest. It is enough. The hour has come. Behold, the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners. ⁴²Arise! Let’s get going. Behold, he who betrays me is at hand.” ⁴³Immediately, while he was still speaking, Judah, one of the twelve, came—and with him a multitude with swords and clubs, from the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders. ⁴⁴Now he who betrayed him had given them a sign, saying, “Whomever I will kiss, that is he. Seize him, and lead him away safely.” ⁴⁵When he had come, immediately he came to him and said, “Rabbi! Rabbi!” and kissed him. ⁴⁶They laid their hands on him and seized him. ⁴⁷But a certain one of those who stood by drew his sword and struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear. ⁴⁸Yeshua answered them, “Have you come out, as against a robber, with swords and clubs to seize me? ⁴⁹I was daily with you in the temple teaching, and you didn’t arrest me. But this is so that the Scriptures might be fulfilled.” ⁵⁰They all left him, and fled. ⁵¹A certain young man followed him, having a linen cloth thrown around himself over his naked body. The young men grabbed him, ⁵²but he left the linen cloth and fled from them naked. ⁵³They led Yeshua away to the high priest. All the chief priests, the elders, and the scribes came together with him. ⁵⁴Peter had followed him from a distance, until he came into the court of the high priest. He was sitting with the officers, and warming himself in the light of the fire. ⁵⁵Now the chief priests and the whole council sought witnesses against Yeshua to put him to death, and found none. ⁵⁶For many gave false testimony against him, and their testimony didn’t agree with each other. ⁵⁷Some stood up and gave false testimony against him, saying, ⁵⁸“We heard him say, ‘I will destroy this temple that is made with hands, and in three days I

^{xxxii}Abba is a Greek spelling for the Aramaic word for “Father” or “Daddy” used in a familiar, respectful, and loving way.

^{xxxi}300 denarii was about a year’s wages for an agricultural laborer.

will build another made without hands.”⁵⁹ Even so, their testimony didn’t agree.⁶⁰ The high priest stood up in the middle, and asked Yeshua, “Have you no answer? What is it which these testify against you?”⁶¹ But he stayed quiet, and answered nothing. Again the high priest asked him, “Are you the Messiah, the Son of the Blessed?”⁶² Yeshua said, “I am. You will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power, and coming with the clouds of the sky.”⁶³ The high priest tore his clothes and said, “What further need have we of witnesses?”⁶⁴ You have heard the blasphemy! What do you think?” They all condemned him to be worthy of death.⁶⁵ Some began to spit on him, and to cover his face, and to beat him with fists, and to tell him, “Prophecy!” The officers struck him with the palms of their hands.⁶⁶ As Peter was in the courtyard below, one of the maids of the high priest came,⁶⁷ and seeing Peter warming himself, she looked at him and said, “You were also with the Nazarene, Yeshua!”⁶⁸ But he denied it, saying, “I neither know nor understand what you are saying.” He went out on the porch, and the rooster crowed.⁶⁹ The maid saw him and began again to tell those who stood by, “This is one of them.”⁷⁰ But he again denied it. After a little while again those who stood by said to Peter, “You truly are one of them, for you are a Galilean, and your speech shows it.”⁷¹ But he began to curse and to swear, “I don’t know this man of whom you speak!”⁷² The rooster crowed the second time. Peter remembered the words that Yeshua said to him, “Before the rooster crows twice, you will deny me three times.” When he thought about that, he wept.

15 Immediately in the morning the chief priests, with the elders, scribes, and the whole council, held a consultation, bound Yeshua, carried him away, and delivered him up to Pilate.² Pilate asked him, “Are you the King of the Jews?” He answered, “So you say.”³ The chief priests accused him of many things.⁴ Pilate again asked him, “Have you no answer? See how many things they testify against you!”⁵ But Yeshua made no further answer, so that Pilate marveled.⁶ Now at the feast he used to release to them one prisoner, whomever they asked of him.⁷ There was one called Barabbas, bound with his fellow insurgents, men who in the insurrection had committed murder.⁸ The multitude, crying aloud, began to ask him to do as he always did for them.⁹ Pilate answered them, saying, “Do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?”¹⁰ For he perceived that for envy the chief priests had delivered him up.¹¹ But the chief priests stirred up the multitude, that he should release Barabbas to them instead.¹² Pilate again asked them, “What then should I do to him whom you call the King of the Jews?”¹³ They cried out again, “Crucify him!”¹⁴ Pilate said to them, “Why, what evil has he done?” But they cried out exceedingly, “Crucify him!”¹⁵ Pilate, wishing to please the multitude, released Barab-

bas to them, and handed over Yeshua, when he had flogged him, to be crucified.¹⁶ The soldiers led him away within the court, which is the Praetorium; and they called together the whole cohort.¹⁷ They clothed him with purple; and weaving a crown of thorns, they put it on him.¹⁸ They began to salute him, “Hail, King of the Jews!”¹⁹ They struck his head with a reed and spat on him, and bowing their knees, did homage to him.²⁰ When they had mocked him, they took the purple cloak off him, and put his own garments on him. They led him out to crucify him.²¹ They compelled one passing by, coming from the country, Simon of Cyrene, the father of Alexander and Rufus, to go with them that he might bear his cross.²² They brought him to the place called Golgotha, which is, being interpreted, “The place of a skull.”²³ They offered him wine mixed with myrrh to drink, but he didn’t take it.²⁴ Crucifying him, they parted his garments among them, casting lots on them, what each should take.²⁵ It was the third hour^{xxxiii} when they crucified him.²⁶ The superscription of his accusation was written over him: “THE KING OF THE JEWS.”²⁷ With him they crucified two robbers, one on his right hand, and one on his left.²⁸ The Scripture was fulfilled which says, “He was counted with transgressors.”^{xxxiv}²⁹ Those who passed by blasphemed him, wagging their heads and saying, “Ha! You who destroy the temple and build it in three days,³⁰ save yourself, and come down from the cross!”³¹ Likewise, also the chief priests mocking among themselves with the scribes said, “He saved others. He can’t save himself.”³² Let the Messiah, the King of Israel, now come down from the cross, that we may see and believe him.”^{xxxv} Those who were crucified with him also insulted him.³³ When the sixth hour^{xxxvi} had come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.^{xxxvii}³⁴ At the ninth hour Yeshua cried with a loud voice, saying, “Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani?” which is, being interpreted, “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?”³⁵ Some of those who stood by, when they heard it, said, “Behold, he is calling Elijah.”³⁶ One ran, and filling a sponge full of vinegar, put it on a reed and gave it to him to drink, saying, “Let him be. Let’s see whether Elijah comes to take him down.”³⁷ Yeshua cried out with a loud voice, and gave up the spirit.³⁸ The veil of the temple was torn in two from the top to the bottom.³⁹ When the centurion, who stood by opposite him, saw that he cried out like this and breathed his last, he said, “Truly this man was the Son of God!”⁴⁰ There were also women watching from afar, among whom were both Miriam Magdalene and Miriam the mother of Jacob the less and of Yosi, and Shalom;⁴¹ who, when he was in Galilee, followed

xxxiii 9:00 a.m.

xxxiv NU omits verse 28.

xxxv TR omits “him”

xxxvi or, noon

xxxvii 3:00 p.m.

him and served him; and many other women who came up with him to Jerusalem. ⁴²When evening had now come, because it was the Preparation Day, that is, the day before the Sabbath, ⁴³Joseph of Arimathaea, a prominent council member who also himself was looking for God's Kingdom, came. He boldly went in to Pilate, and asked for Yeshua's body. ⁴⁴Pilate was surprised to hear that he was already dead; and summoning the centurion, he asked him whether he had been dead long. ⁴⁵When he found out from the centurion, he granted the body to Joseph. ⁴⁶He bought a linen cloth, and taking him down, wound him in the linen cloth and laid him in a tomb which had been cut out of a rock. He rolled a stone against the door of the tomb. ⁴⁷Miriam Magdalene and Miriam the mother of Yosi, saw where he was laid.

16When the Sabbath was past, Miriam Magdalene, and Miriam the mother of Jacob, and Shalom bought spices, that they might come and anoint him. ²Very early on the first day of the week, they came to the tomb when the sun had risen. ³They were saying among themselves, "Who will roll away the stone from the door of the tomb for us?" ⁴for it was very big. Looking up, they saw that the stone was rolled back. ⁵Entering into the tomb, they saw a young man sitting on the right side, dressed in a white robe; and they were amazed. ⁶He said to them, "Don't be amazed. You seek Yeshua, the Nazarene, who has been crucified. He has risen! He is not here. See the place where they laid him! ⁷But go, tell his disciples and Peter, 'He goes before you into Galilee. There you will see him, as he said to you.'" ⁸They went out, ^{xxxviii} and fled from the tomb, for trembling and astonishment had come on them. They said nothing to anyone; for they were afraid. ^{xxxix} ^{9x1} Now when he had risen early on the first day of the week, he appeared first to Miriam Magdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons. ¹⁰She went and told those who had been with him, as they mourned and wept. ¹¹When they heard that he was alive and had been seen by her, they disbelieved. ¹²After these things he was revealed in another form to two of them as they walked, on their way into the country. ¹³They went away and told it to the rest. They didn't believe them, either. ¹⁴Afterward he was revealed to the Eleven themselves as they sat at the table; and he rebuked them for their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they didn't believe those who had seen him after he had risen. ¹⁵He said to them, "Go into all the world and proclaim the Good News to the whole creation. ¹⁶He who believes and is immersed will be saved; but he who disbelieves will be condemned. ¹⁷These signs will ac-

company those who believe: in my name they will cast out demons; they will speak with new languages; ¹⁸they will take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it will in no way hurt them; they will lay hands on the sick, and they will recover." ¹⁹So then the Lord, ^{xli} after he had spoken to them, was received up into heaven and sat down at the right hand of God. ²⁰They went out and preached everywhere, the Lord working with them and confirming the word by the signs that followed. Amen.

^{xxxviii}TR adds "quickly"

^{xxxix}One isolated manuscript omits verses 9-20 but adds this "short ending of Mark" to the end of verse 8:

^{xli}NU includes the text of verses 9-20, but mentions in a footnote that a few manuscripts omitted it. The translators of the World English Bible regard

^{xli}NU adds "Yeshua"

Luke

¹Since many have undertaken to set in order a narrative concerning those matters which have been fulfilled among us, ²even as those who from the beginning were eyewitnesses and servants of the word delivered them to us, ³it seemed good to me also, having traced the course of all things accurately from the first, to write to you in order, most excellent Theophilus; ⁴that you might know the certainty concerning the things in which you were instructed. ⁵There was in the days of Herod, the king of Judea, a certain priest named Zechariah, of the priestly division of Abijah. He had a wife of the daughters of Aaron, and her name was Elisheva. ⁶They were both righteous before God, walking blamelessly in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord. ⁷But they had no child, because Elisheva was barren, and they both were well advanced in years. ⁸Now while he executed the priest's office before God in the order of his division ⁹according to the custom of the priest's office, his lot was to enter into the temple of the Lord and burn incense. ¹⁰The whole multitude of the people were praying outside at the hour of incense. ¹¹An angel of the Lord appeared to him, standing on the right side of the altar of incense. ¹²Zechariah was troubled when he saw him, and fear fell upon him. ¹³But the angel said to him, "Don't be afraid, Zechariah, because your request has been heard. Your wife, Elisheva, will bear you a son, and you shall call his name Yochanan. ¹⁴You will have joy and gladness, and many will rejoice at his birth. ¹⁵For he will be great in the sight of the Lord, and he will drink no wine nor strong drink. He will be filled with the Holy Spirit, even from his mother's womb. ¹⁶He will turn many of the children of Israel to the Lord their God. ¹⁷He will go before him in the spirit and power of Elijah, 'to turn the hearts of the fathers to the children,' and the disobedient to the wisdom of the just; to prepare a people prepared for the Lord." ¹⁸Zechariah said to the angel, "How can I be sure of this? For I am an old man, and my wife is well advanced in years." ¹⁹The angel answered him, "I am Gabriel, who stands in the presence of God. I was sent to speak to you and to bring you this good news. ²⁰Behold, ⁱ you will be silent and not able to speak until

the day that these things will happen, because you didn't believe my words, which will be fulfilled in their proper time." ²¹The people were waiting for Zechariah, and they marveled that he delayed in the temple. ²²When he came out, he could not speak to them. They perceived that he had seen a vision in the temple. He continued making signs to them, and remained mute. ²³When the days of his service were fulfilled, he departed to his house. ²⁴After these days Elisheva his wife conceived, and she hid herself five months, saying, ²⁵"Thus has the Lord done to me in the days in which he looked at me, to take away my reproach among men." ²⁶Now in the sixth month, the angel Gabriel was sent from God to a city of Galilee named Nazareth, ²⁷to a virgin pledged to be married to a man whose name was Joseph, of David's house. The virgin's name was Miriam. ²⁸Having come in, the angel said to her, "Rejoice, you highly favored one! The Lord is with you. Blessed are you among women!" ²⁹But when she saw him, she was greatly troubled at the saying, and considered what kind of salutation this might be. ³⁰The angel said to her, "Don't be afraid, Miriam, for you have found favor with God. ³¹Behold, you will conceive in your womb and give birth to a son, and shall name him 'Yeshua.' ³²He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High. The Lord God will give him the throne of his father David, ³³and he will reign over the house of Jacob forever. There will be no end to his Kingdom." ³⁴Miriam said to the angel, "How can this be, seeing I am a virgin?" ³⁵The angel answered her, "The Holy Spirit will come on you, and the power of the Most High will overshadow you. Therefore also the holy one who is born from you will be called the Son of God. ³⁶Behold, Elisheva your relative also has conceived a son in her old age; and this is the sixth month with her who was called barren. ³⁷For nothing spoken by God is impossible." ⁱⁱ ³⁸Miriam said, "Behold, the servant of the Lord; let it be done to me according to your word." Then the angel departed from her. ³⁹Miriam arose in those days and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Judah, ⁴⁰and entered into the house of Zechariah and greeted Elisheva. ⁴¹When Elisheva heard Miriam's greeting, the baby leaped in her womb; and Elisheva was filled with the

ⁱ"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

ⁱⁱor, "For everything spoken by God is possible."

Holy Spirit. ⁴²She called out with a loud voice and said, "Blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb! ⁴³Why am I so favored, that the mother of my Lord should come to me? ⁴⁴For behold, when the voice of your greeting came into my ears, the baby leaped in my womb for joy! ⁴⁵Blessed is she who believed, for there will be a fulfillment of the things which have been spoken to her from the Lord!" ⁴⁶Miriam said, "My soul magnifies the Lord. ⁴⁷My spirit has rejoiced in God my Savior, ⁴⁸for he has looked at the humble state of his servant. For behold, from now on, all generations will call me blessed. ⁴⁹For he who is mighty has done great things for me. Holy is his name. ⁵⁰His mercy is for generations and generations on those who fear him. ⁵¹He has shown strength with his arm. He has scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts. ⁵²He has put down princes from their thrones, and has exalted the lowly. ⁵³He has filled the hungry with good things. He has sent the rich away empty. ⁵⁴He has given help to Israel, his servant, that he might remember mercy, ⁵⁵as he spoke to our fathers, to Abraham and his offspring ⁱⁱⁱ forever." ⁵⁶Miriam stayed with her about three months, and then returned to her house. ⁵⁷Now the time that Elisheva should give birth was fulfilled, and she gave birth to a son. ⁵⁸Her neighbors and her relatives heard that the Lord had magnified his mercy toward her, and they rejoiced with her. ⁵⁹On the eighth day, they came to circumcise the child; and they would have called him Zechariah, after the name of his father. ⁶⁰His mother answered, "Not so; but he will be called Yochanan." ⁶¹They said to her, "There is no one among your relatives who is called by this name." ⁶²They made signs to his father, what he would have him called. ⁶³He asked for a writing tablet, and wrote, "His name is Yochanan." They all marveled. ⁶⁴His mouth was opened immediately and his tongue freed, and he spoke, blessing God. ⁶⁵Fear came on all who lived around them, and all these sayings were talked about throughout all the hill country of Judea. ⁶⁶All who heard them laid them up in their heart, saying, "What then will this child be?" The hand of the Lord was with him. ⁶⁷His father Zechariah was filled with the Holy Spirit, and prophesied, saying, ⁶⁸"Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel, for he has visited and redeemed his people; ⁶⁹and has raised up a horn of salvation for us in the house of his servant David ⁷⁰(as he spoke by the mouth of his holy prophets who have been from of old), ⁷¹salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all who hate us; ⁷²to show mercy toward our fathers, to remember his holy covenant, ⁷³the oath which he swore to Abraham our father, ⁷⁴to grant to us that we, being delivered out of the hand of our enemies, should serve him without fear, ⁷⁵in holiness and righteousness before him all the days of our life. ⁷⁶And you, child, will be called a prophet of the Most High; for you will go before

the face of the Lord to prepare his ways, ⁷⁷to give knowledge of salvation to his people by the remission of their sins, ⁷⁸because of the tender mercy of our God, by which the dawn from on high will visit us, ⁷⁹to shine on those who sit in darkness and the shadow of death; to guide our feet into the way of peace." ⁸⁰The child was growing and becoming strong in spirit, and was in the desert until the day of his public appearance to Israel.

2Now in those days, a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that all the world should be enrolled. ²This was the first enrollment made when Quirinius was governor of Syria. ³All went to enroll themselves, everyone to his own city. ⁴Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judea, to David's city, which is called Bethlehem, because he was of the house and family of David, ⁵to enroll himself with Miriam, who was pledged to be married to him as wife, being pregnant. ⁶While they were there, the day had come for her to give birth. ⁷She gave birth to her firstborn son. She wrapped him in bands of cloth and laid him in a feeding trough, because there was no room for them in the inn. ⁸There were shepherds in the same country staying in the field, and keeping watch by night over their flock. ⁹Behold, an angel of the Lord stood by them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they were terrified. ¹⁰The angel said to them, "Don't be afraid, for behold, I bring you good news of great joy which will be to all the people. ¹¹For there is born to you today, in David's city, a Savior, who is Messiah ^{iv} the Lord. ¹²This is the sign to you: you will find a baby wrapped in strips of cloth, lying in a feeding trough." ¹³Suddenly, there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly army praising God and saying, ¹⁴"Glory to God in the highest, on earth peace, good will toward men." ¹⁵When the angels went away from them into the sky, the shepherds said to one another, "Let's go to Bethlehem, now, and see this thing that has happened, which the Lord has made known to us." ¹⁶They came with haste and found both Miriam and Joseph, and the baby was lying in the feeding trough. ¹⁷When they saw it, they publicized widely the saying which was spoken to them about this child. ¹⁸All who heard it wondered at the things which were spoken to them by the shepherds. ¹⁹But Miriam kept all these sayings, pondering them in her heart. ²⁰The shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things that they had heard and seen, just as it was told them. ²¹When eight days were fulfilled for the circumcision of the child, his name was called Yeshua, which was given by the angel before he was conceived in the womb. ²²When the days of their purification according to the Torah of Moses were fulfilled, they brought him up to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord ²³(as it is written in the Torah of the Lord, "Every male who opens the womb shall be called holy to the

ⁱⁱⁱor, seed

^{iv}"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

Lord”),²⁴ and to offer a sacrifice according to that which is said in the Torah of the Lord, “A pair of turtledoves, or two young pigeons.”²⁵ Behold, there was a man in Jerusalem whose name was Simeon. This man was righteous and devout, looking for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was on him.²⁶ It had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit that he should not see death before he had seen the Lord’s Messiah.^v ²⁷He came in the Spirit into the temple. When the parents brought in the child, Yeshua, that they might do concerning him according to the requirement of the Torah,²⁸ then he received him into his arms and blessed God, and said,²⁹ “Now you are releasing your servant, Master, according to your word, in peace; ³⁰for my eyes have seen your salvation, ³¹which you have prepared before the face of all peoples; ³²a light for revelation to the nations, and the glory of your people Israel.” ³³Joseph and his mother were marveling at the things which were spoken concerning him. ³⁴Simeon blessed them, and said to Miriam, his mother, “Behold, this child is appointed for the falling and the rising of many in Israel, and for a sign which is spoken against. ³⁵Yes, a sword will pierce through your own soul, that the thoughts of many hearts may be revealed.” ³⁶There was one Hannah, a prophetess, the daughter of Penuel, of the tribe of Asher (she was of a great age, having lived with a husband seven years from her virginity, ³⁷and she had been a widow for about eighty-four years), who didn’t depart from the temple, worshiping with fastings and petitions night and day. ³⁸Coming up at that very hour, she gave thanks to the Lord, and spoke of him to all those who were looking for redemption in Jerusalem. ³⁹When they had accomplished all things that were according to the Torah of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their own city, Nazareth. ⁴⁰The child was growing, and was becoming strong in spirit, being filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was upon him. ⁴¹His parents went every year to Jerusalem at the feast of the Passover. ⁴²When he was twelve years old, they went up to Jerusalem according to the custom of the feast; ⁴³and when they had fulfilled the days, as they were returning, the boy Yeshua stayed behind in Jerusalem. Joseph and his mother didn’t know it, ⁴⁴but supposing him to be in the company, they went a day’s journey; and they looked for him among their relatives and acquaintances. ⁴⁵When they didn’t find him, they returned to Jerusalem, looking for him. ⁴⁶After three days they found him in the temple, sitting in the middle of the teachers, both listening to them and asking them questions. ⁴⁷All who heard him were amazed at his understanding and his answers. ⁴⁸When they saw him, they were astonished; and his mother said to him, “Son, why have you treated us this way? Behold, your father and I were anxiously looking for you.” ⁴⁹He said to them, “Why were you looking for me? Didn’t you know that I

must be in my Father’s house?”⁵⁰ They didn’t understand the saying which he spoke to them. ⁵¹And he went down with them and came to Nazareth. He was subject to them, and his mother kept all these sayings in her heart. ⁵²And Yeshua increased in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and men.

3 Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being governor of Judea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and his brother Philip tetrarch of the region of Ituraea and Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilene, ²during the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, the word of God came to Yochanan, the son of Zechariah, in the wilderness. ³He came into all the region around the Jordan, proclaiming the immersion of repentance for remission of sins. ⁴As it is written in the scroll of the words of Isaiah the prophet, “The voice of one crying in the wilderness, ‘Make ready the way of the Lord. Make his paths straight. ⁵Every valley will be filled. Every mountain and hill will be brought low. The crooked will become straight, and the rough ways smooth. ⁶All flesh will see God’s salvation.’” ⁷He said therefore to the multitudes who went out to be immersed by him, “You offspring of vipers, who warned you to flee from the wrath to come? ⁸Therefore produce fruits worthy of repentance, and don’t begin to say among yourselves, ‘We have Abraham for our father;’ for I tell you that God is able to raise up children to Abraham from these stones! ⁹Even now the ax also lies at the root of the trees. Every tree therefore that doesn’t produce good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.” ¹⁰The multitudes asked him, “What then must we do?” ¹¹He answered them, “He who has two coats, let him give to him who has none. He who has food, let him do likewise.” ¹²Tax collectors also came to be immersed, and they said to him, “Rabbi, what must we do?” ¹³He said to them, “Collect no more than that which is appointed to you.” ¹⁴Soldiers also asked him, saying, “What about us? What must we do?” He said to them, “Extort from no one by violence, neither accuse anyone wrongfully. Be content with your wages.” ¹⁵As the people were in expectation, and all men reasoned in their hearts concerning Yochanan, whether perhaps he was the Messiah, ¹⁶Yochanan answered them all, “I indeed immerse you with water, but he comes who is mightier than I, the strap of whose sandals I am not worthy to loosen. He will immerse you in the Holy Spirit and fire. ¹⁷His winnowing fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly cleanse his threshing floor, and will gather the wheat into his barn; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.” ¹⁸Then with many other exhortations he preached good news to the people, ¹⁹but Herod the tetrarch, ^{vi} being reproved by him for Herodias, his brother’s ^{vii} wife, and for all the evil

^v“Christ” (Greek) and “Messiah” (Hebrew) both mean “Anointed One”

^{vi}a tetrarch is one of four governors of a province

^{vii}TR reads “brother Philip’s” instead of “brother’s”

things which Herod had done, ²⁰added this also to them all, that he shut up Yochanan in prison. ²¹Now when all the people were immersed, Yeshua also had been immersed and was praying. The sky was opened, ²²and the Holy Spirit descended in a bodily form like a dove on him; and a voice came out of the sky, saying “You are my beloved Son. In you I am well pleased.” ²³Yeshua himself, when he began to teach, was about thirty years old, being the son (as was supposed) of Joseph, the son of Eli, ²⁴the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, the son of Melchi, the son of Jannai, the son of Joseph, ²⁵the son of Mattithiah, the son of Amos, the son of Nahum, the son of Esli, the son of Naggai, ²⁶the son of Maath, the son of Mattithiah, the son of Shimei, the son of Joseph, the son of Judah, ²⁷the son of Yochanan, the son of Rhesa, the son of Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel, the son of Neri, ²⁸the son of Melchi, the son of Addi, the son of Cosam, the son of Elmodam, the son of Er, ²⁹the son of Yosi, the son of Eliezer, the son of Jorim, the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, ³⁰the son of Simeon, the son of Judah, the son of Joseph, the son of Jonan, the son of Eliakim, ³¹the son of Maleah, the son of Manah, the son of Mattathah, the son of Nathan, the son of David, ³²the son of Jesse, the son of Obed, the son of Boaz, the son of Salmon, the son of Nahshon, ³³the son of Amminadab, the son of Ram, ^{viii}the son of Hezron, the son of Perez, the son of Judah, ³⁴the son of Jacob, the son of Isaac, the son of Abraham, the son of Terah, the son of Nahor, ³⁵the son of Serug, the son of Reu, the son of Peleg, the son of Eber, the son of Shelah, ³⁶the son of Kenan, the son of Arpachshad, the son of Shem, the son of Noah, the son of Lamech, ³⁷the son of Methuselah, the son of Enoch, the son of Jared, the son of Mahalalel, the son of Kenan, ³⁸the son of Enosh, the son of Seth, the son of Adam, the son of God.

⁴Yeshua, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness ²for forty days, being tempted by the devil. He ate nothing in those days. Afterward, when they were completed, he was hungry. ³The devil said to him, “If you are the Son of God, command this stone to become bread.” ⁴Yeshua answered him, saying, “It is written, ‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.’” ⁵The devil, leading him up on a high mountain, showed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. ⁶The devil said to him, “I will give you all this authority and their glory, for it has been delivered to me, and I give it to whomever I want. ⁷If you therefore will worship before me, it will all be yours.” ⁸Yeshua answered him, “Get behind me, Satan! For it is written, ‘You shall worship the Lord your God, and you shall serve him only.’” ⁹He led him to Jerusalem and set him on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, cast yourself down from

here, ¹⁰for it is written, ‘He will put his angels in charge of you, to guard you;’ ¹¹and, ‘On their hands they will bear you up, lest perhaps you dash your foot against a stone.’” ¹²Yeshua answering, said to him, “It has been said, ‘You shall not tempt the Lord your God.’” ¹³When the devil had completed every temptation, he departed from him until another time. ¹⁴Yeshua returned in the power of the Spirit into Galilee, and news about him spread through all the surrounding area. ¹⁵He taught in their synagogues, being glorified by all. ¹⁶He came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up. He entered, as was his custom, into the synagogue on the Sabbath day, and stood up to read. ¹⁷The scroll of the prophet Isaiah was handed to him. He opened the scroll, and found the place where it was written, ¹⁸“The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to heal the broken hearted, ^{ix} to proclaim release to the captives, recovering of sight to the blind, to deliver those who are crushed, ¹⁹and to proclaim the acceptable year of the Lord.” ²⁰He closed the scroll, gave it back to the shammash, and sat down. The eyes of all in the synagogue were fastened on him. ²¹He began to tell them, “Today, this Scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing.” ²²All testified about him and wondered at the gracious words which proceeded out of his mouth; and they said, “Isn’t this Joseph’s son?” ²³He said to them, “Doubtless you will tell me this proverb, ‘Physician, heal yourself! Whatever we have heard done at Capernaum, do also here in your hometown.’” ²⁴He said, “Most certainly I tell you, no prophet is acceptable in his hometown. ²⁵But truly I tell you, there were many widows in Israel in the days of Elijah, when the sky was shut up three years and six months, when a great famine came over all the land. ²⁶Elijah was sent to none of them, except to Zarephath, in the land of Sidon, to a woman who was a widow. ²⁷There were many lepers in Israel in the time of Elisha the prophet, yet not one of them was cleansed, except Naaman, the Syrian.” ²⁸They were all filled with wrath in the synagogue as they heard these things. ²⁹They rose up, threw him out of the city, and led him to the brow of the hill that their city was built on, that they might throw him off the cliff. ³⁰But he, passing through the middle of them, went his way. ³¹He came down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee. He was teaching them on the Sabbath day, ³²and they were astonished at his teaching, for his word was with authority. ³³In the synagogue there was a man who had a spirit of an unclean demon; and he cried out with a loud voice, ³⁴saying, “Ah! what have we to do with you, Yeshua of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are: the Holy One of God!” ³⁵Yeshua rebuked him, saying, “Be silent and come out of him!” When the demon had thrown him down in the middle of them, he came out of him, having done him no harm. ³⁶Amazement came on all

^{viii}NU reads “Admin, the son of Arni” instead of “Ram”

^{ix}NU omits “to heal the broken hearted”

and they spoke together, one with another, saying, "What is this word? For with authority and power he commands the unclean spirits, and they come out!" ³⁷News about him went out into every place of the surrounding region. ³⁸He rose up from the synagogue and entered into Simon's house. Simon's mother-in-law was afflicted with a great fever, and they begged him to help her. ³⁹He stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. Immediately she rose up and served them. ⁴⁰When the sun was setting, all those who had any sick with various diseases brought them to him; and he laid his hands on every one of them, and healed them. ⁴¹Demons also came out of many, crying out and saying, "You are the Messiah, the Son of God!" Rebuking them, he didn't allow them to speak, because they knew that he was the Messiah. ⁴²When it was day, he departed and went into an uninhabited place and the multitudes looked for him, and came to him, and held on to him, so that he wouldn't go away from them. ⁴³But he said to them, "I must proclaim the good news of God's Kingdom to the other cities also. For this reason I have been sent." ⁴⁴He was proclaiming in the synagogues of Galilee.

5Now while the multitude pressed on him and heard the word of God, he was standing by the lake of Genesaret. ²He saw two boats standing by the lake, but the fishermen had gone out of them and were washing their nets. ³He entered into one of the boats, which was Simon's, and asked him to put out a little from the land. He sat down and taught the multitudes from the boat. ⁴When he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, "Put out into the deep and let down your nets for a catch." ⁵Simon answered him, "Master, we worked all night and caught nothing; but at your word I will let down the net." ⁶When they had done this, they caught a great multitude of fish, and their net was breaking. ⁷They beckoned to their partners in the other boat, that they should come and help them. They came and filled both boats, so that they began to sink. ⁸But Simon Peter, when he saw it, fell down at Yeshua's knees, saying, "Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, Lord." ⁹For he was amazed, and all who were with him, at the catch of fish which they had caught; ¹⁰and so also were Jacob and Yochanan, sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon. Yeshua said to Simon, "Don't be afraid. From now on you will be catching people alive." ¹¹When they had brought their boats to land, they left everything, and followed him. ¹²While he was in one of the cities, behold, there was a man full of leprosy. When he saw Yeshua, he fell on his face and begged him, saying, "Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean." ¹³He stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, "I want to. Be made clean." Immediately the leprosy left him. ¹⁴He commanded him to tell no one, "But go your way and show yourself to the priest, and offer for

your cleansing according to what Moses commanded, for a testimony to them." ¹⁵But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶But he withdrew himself into the desert and prayed. ¹⁷On one of those days, he was teaching; and there were Pharisees and teachers of the Torah sitting by who had come out of every village of Galilee, Judea, and Jerusalem. The power of the Lord was with him to heal them. ¹⁸Behold, men brought a paralyzed man on a cot, and they sought to bring him in to lay before Yeshua. ¹⁹Not finding a way to bring him in because of the multitude, they went up to the housetop and let him down through the tiles with his cot into the middle before Yeshua. ²⁰Seeing their faith, he said to him, "Man, your sins are forgiven you." ²¹The scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying, "Who is this who speaks blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone?" ²²But Yeshua, perceiving their thoughts, answered them, "Why are you reasoning so in your hearts? ²³Which is easier to say, 'Your sins are forgiven you,' or to say, 'Arise and walk?' ²⁴But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins," he said to the paralyzed man, "I tell you, arise, take up your cot, and go to your house." ²⁵Immediately he rose up before them, and took up that which he was laying on, and departed to his house, glorifying God. ²⁶Amazement took hold on all, and they glorified God. They were filled with fear, saying, "We have seen strange things today." ²⁷After these things he went out and saw a tax collector named Levi sitting at the tax office, and said to him, "Follow me!" ²⁸He left everything, and rose up and followed him. ²⁹Levi made a great feast for him in his house. There was a great crowd of tax collectors and others who were reclining with them. ³⁰Their scribes and the Pharisees murmured against his disciples, saying, "Why do you eat and drink with the tax collectors and sinners?" ³¹Yeshua answered them, "Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick do. ³²I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners, to repentance." ³³They said to him, "Why do Yochanan's disciples often fast and pray, likewise also the disciples of the Pharisees, but yours eat and drink?" ³⁴He said to them, "Can you make the friends of the bridegroom fast while the bridegroom is with them? ³⁵But the days will come when the bridegroom will be taken away from them. Then they will fast in those days." ³⁶He also told a parable to them. "No one puts a piece from a new garment on an old garment, or else he will tear the new, and also the piece from the new will not match the old. ³⁷No one puts new wine into old wine skins, or else the new wine will burst the skins, and it will be spilled and the skins will be destroyed. ³⁸But new wine must be put into fresh wine skins, and both are preserved. ³⁹No man having drunk old wine immediately desires new, for he says, 'The old is better.'"

6Now on the second Sabbath after the first, he was going through the grain fields. His disciples plucked the heads of grain and ate, rubbing them in their hands. 2But some of the Pharisees said to them, "Why do you do that which is not lawful to do on the Sabbath day?" 3Yeshua, answering them, said, "Haven't you read what David did when he was hungry, he and those who were with him, 4how he entered into God's house, and took and ate the show bread, and gave also to those who were with him, which is not lawful to eat except for the priests alone?" 5He said to them, "The Son of Man is lord of the Sabbath." 6It also happened on another Sabbath that he entered into the synagogue and taught. There was a man there, and his right hand was withered. 7The scribes and the Pharisees watched him, to see whether he would heal on the Sabbath, that they might find an accusation against him. 8But he knew their thoughts; and he said to the man who had the withered hand, "Rise up and stand in the middle." He arose and stood. 9Then Yeshua said to them, "I will ask you something: Is it lawful on the Sabbath to do good, or to do harm? To save a life, or to kill?" 10He looked around at them all, and said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He did, and his hand was restored as sound as the other. 11But they were filled with rage, and talked with one another about what they might do to Yeshua. 12In these days, he went out to the mountain to pray, and he continued all night in prayer to God. 13When it was day, he called his disciples, and from them he chose twelve, whom he also named emissaries: 14Simon, whom he also named Peter; Andrew, his brother; Jacob; Yochanan; Philip; Bartholomew; 15Matthew; Thomas; Jacob the son of Halfai; Simon who was called the Zealot; 16Judah the son of Jacob; and Judah Iscariot, who also became a traitor. 17He came down with them and stood on a level place, with a crowd of his disciples and a great number of the people from all Judea and Jerusalem and the sea coast of Tyre and Sidon, who came to hear him and to be healed of their diseases, 18as well as those who were troubled by unclean spirits; and they were being healed. 19All the multitude sought to touch him, for power came out of him and healed them all. 20He lifted up his eyes to his disciples, and said: "Blessed are you who are poor, for God's Kingdom is yours. 21Blessed are you who hunger now, for you will be filled. Blessed are you who weep now, for you will laugh. 22Blessed are you when men hate you, and when they exclude and mock you, and throw out your name as evil, for the Son of Man's sake. 23Rejoice in that day and leap for joy, for behold, your reward is great in heaven, for their fathers did the same thing to the prophets. 24" But woe to you who are rich! For you have received your consolation. 25Woe to you, you who are full now, for you will be hungry. Woe to you who laugh now, for you

will mourn and weep. 26Woe, ^x when ^{xi} men speak well of you, for their fathers did the same thing to the false prophets. 27" But I tell you who hear: love your enemies, do good to those who hate you, 28bless those who curse you, and pray for those who mistreat you. 29To him who strikes you on the cheek, offer also the other; and from him who takes away your cloak, don't withhold your coat also. 30Give to everyone who asks you, and don't ask him who takes away your goods to give them back again. 31" As you would like people to do to you, do exactly so to them. 32" If you love those who love you, what credit is that to you? For even sinners love those who love them. 33If you do good to those who do good to you, what credit is that to you? For even sinners do the same. 34If you lend to those from whom you hope to receive, what credit is that to you? Even sinners lend to sinners, to receive back as much. 35But love your enemies, and do good, and lend, expecting nothing back; and your reward will be great, and you will be children of the Most High; for he is kind toward the unthankful and evil. 36"Therefore be merciful, even as your Father is also merciful. 37Don't judge, and you won't be judged. Don't condemn, and you won't be condemned. Set free, and you will be set free. 38"Give, and it will be given to you: good measure, pressed down, shaken together, and running over, will be given to you. ^{xii} For with the same measure you measure it will be measured back to you." 39He spoke a parable to them. "Can the blind guide the blind? Won't they both fall into a pit? 40A disciple is not above his rabbi, but everyone when he is fully trained will be like his rabbi. 41Why do you see the speck of chaff that is in your brother's eye, but don't consider the beam that is in your own eye? 42Or how can you tell your brother, 'Brother, let me remove the speck of chaff that is in your eye,' when you yourself don't see the beam that is in your own eye? You hypocrite! First remove the beam from your own eye, and then you can see clearly to remove the speck of chaff that is in your brother's eye. 43" For there is no good tree that produces rotten fruit, nor again a rotten tree that produces good fruit. 44For each tree is known by its own fruit. For people don't gather figs from thorns, nor do they gather grapes from a bramble bush. 45The good man out of the good treasure of his heart brings out that which is good, and the evil man out of the evil treasure of his heart brings out that which is evil, for out of the abundance of the heart, his mouth speaks. 46" Why do you call me, 'Lord, Lord,' and don't do the things which I say? 47Everyone who comes to me, and hears my words and does them, I will show you who he is like. 48He is like a man building a house, who dug and went deep and laid a foundation on the rock. When a flood arose, the stream broke against that house, and could not

^xTR adds "to you"

^{xi}TR adds "all"

^{xii}literally, into your bosom.

shake it, because it was founded on the rock. ⁴⁹But he who hears and doesn't do, is like a man who built a house on the earth without a foundation, against which the stream broke, and immediately it fell; and the ruin of that house was great."

⁷After he had finished speaking in the hearing of the people, he entered into Capernaum. ²A certain centurion's servant, who was dear to him, was sick and at the point of death. ³When he heard about Yeshua, he sent to him Jewish elders, asking him to come and save his servant. ⁴When they came to Yeshua, they begged him earnestly, saying, "He is worthy for you to do this for him, ⁵for he loves our nation, and he built our synagogue for us." ⁶Yeshua went with them. When he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying to him, "Lord, don't trouble yourself, for I am not worthy for you to come under my roof. ⁷Therefore I didn't even think myself worthy to come to you; but say the word, and my servant will be healed. ⁸For I also am a man placed under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, 'Go!' and he goes; and to another, 'Come!' and he comes; and to my servant, 'Do this,' and he does it." ⁹When Yeshua heard these things, he marveled at him, and turned and said to the multitude who followed him, "I tell you, I have not found such great faith, no, not in Israel." ¹⁰Those who were sent, returning to the house, found that the servant who had been sick was well. ¹¹Soon afterwards, he went to a city called Nain. Many of his disciples, along with a great multitude, went with him. ¹²Now when he came near to the gate of the city, behold, one who was dead was carried out, the only born ^{xiii} son of his mother, and she was a widow. Many people of the city were with her. ¹³When the Lord saw her, he had compassion on her and said to her, "Don't cry." ¹⁴He came near and touched the coffin, and the bearers stood still. He said, "Young man, I tell you, arise!" ¹⁵He who was dead sat up and began to speak. Then he gave him to his mother. ¹⁶Fear took hold of all, and they glorified God, saying, "A great prophet has arisen among us!" and, "God has visited his people!" ¹⁷This report went out concerning him in the whole of Judea and in all the surrounding region. ¹⁸The disciples of Yochanan told him about all these things. ¹⁹Yochanan, calling to himself two of his disciples, sent them to Yeshua, saying, "Are you the one who is coming, or should we look for another?" ²⁰When the men had come to him, they said, "Yochanan the Immerser has sent us to you, saying, 'Are you he who comes, or should we look for another?'" ²¹In that hour he cured many of diseases and plagues and evil spirits; and to many who were blind he gave sight. ²²Yeshua answered them, "Go and tell Yochanan the things which you have seen and heard: that the blind receive their sight, the lame

walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have good news preached to them. ²³Blessed is he who finds no occasion for stumbling in me." ²⁴When Yochanan's messengers had departed, he began to tell the multitudes about Yochanan, "What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind? ²⁵But what did you go out to see? A man clothed in soft clothing? Behold, those who are gorgeously dressed and live delicately are in kings' courts. ²⁶But what did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and much more than a prophet. ²⁷This is he of whom it is written, 'Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who will prepare your way before you.' ²⁸" For I tell you, among those who are born of women there is not a greater prophet than Yochanan the Immerser; yet he who is least in God's Kingdom is greater than he." ²⁹When all the people and the tax collectors heard this, they declared God to be just, having been immersed with Yochanan's immersion. ³⁰But the Pharisees and the Torah scholars rejected the counsel of God, not being immersed by him themselves. ³¹^{xiv} "To what then should I compare the people of this generation? What are they like? ³²They are like children who sit in the marketplace and call to one another, saying, 'We piped to you, and you didn't dance. We mourned, and you didn't weep.' ³³For Yochanan the Immerser came neither eating bread nor drinking wine, and you say, 'He has a demon.' ³⁴The Son of Man has come eating and drinking, and you say, 'Behold, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!' ³⁵Wisdom is justified by all her children." ³⁶One of the Pharisees invited him to eat with him. He entered into the Pharisee's house and sat at the table. ³⁷Behold, a woman in the city who was a sinner, when she knew that he was reclining in the Pharisee's house, brought an alabaster jar of ointment. ³⁸Standing behind at his feet weeping, she began to wet his feet with her tears, and she wiped them with the hair of her head, kissed his feet, and anointed them with the ointment. ³⁹Now when the Pharisee who had invited him saw it, he said to himself, "This man, if he were a prophet, would have perceived who and what kind of woman this is who touches him, that she is a sinner." ⁴⁰Yeshua answered him, "Simon, I have something to tell you." He said, "Rabbi, say on." ⁴¹"A certain lender had two debtors. The one owed five hundred denarii, and the other fifty. ⁴²When they couldn't pay, he forgave them both. Which of them therefore will love him most?" ⁴³Simon answered, "He, I suppose, to whom he forgave the most." He said to him, "You have judged correctly." ⁴⁴Turning to the woman, he said to Simon, "Do you see this woman? I entered into your house, and you gave me no water for my feet, but she has wet my feet with her tears, and wiped them with the hair of her head. ⁴⁵You gave me no kiss, but she, since the time I came in, has not ceased to kiss my feet. ⁴⁶You

^{xiii}The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μόνος", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

^{xiv}TR adds "But the Lord said,"

didn't anoint my head with oil, but she has anointed my feet with ointment. ⁴⁷Therefore I tell you, her sins, which are many, are forgiven, for she loved much. But one to whom little is forgiven, loves little." ⁴⁸He said to her, "Your sins are forgiven." ⁴⁹Those who sat at the table with him began to say to themselves, "Who is this who even forgives sins?" ⁵⁰He said to the woman, "Your faith has saved you. Go in peace."

⁸Soon afterwards, he went about through cities and villages, proclaiming and bringing the good news of God's Kingdom. With him were the twelve, ²and certain women who had been healed of evil spirits and infirmities: Miriam who was called Magdalene, from whom seven demons had gone out; ³and Yochanah, the wife of Kuza, Herod's steward; Shoshanah; and many others who served them ^{xv} from their possessions. ⁴When a great multitude came together and people from every city were coming to him, he spoke by a parable: ⁵"The farmer went out to sow his seed. As he sowed, some fell along the road, and it was trampled under foot, and the birds of the sky devoured it. ⁶Other seed fell on the rock, and as soon as it grew, it withered away, because it had no moisture. ⁷Other fell amid the thorns, and the thorns grew with it and choked it. ⁸Other fell into the good ground and grew and produced one hundred times as much fruit." As he said these things, he called out, "He who has ears to hear, let him hear!" ⁹Then his disciples asked him, "What does this parable mean?" ¹⁰He said, "To you it is given to know the mysteries of God's Kingdom, but to the rest it is given in parables, that 'seeing they may not see, and hearing they may not understand.' ¹¹" Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God. ¹²Those along the road are those who hear; then the devil comes and takes away the word from their heart, that they may not believe and be saved. ¹³Those on the rock are they who, when they hear, receive the word with joy; but these have no root. They believe for a while, then fall away in time of temptation. ¹⁴What fell among the thorns, these are those who have heard, and as they go on their way they are choked with cares, riches, and pleasures of life; and they bring no fruit to maturity. ¹⁵Those in the good ground, these are those who with an honest and good heart, having heard the word, hold it tightly, and produce fruit with perseverance. ¹⁶"No one, when he has lit a lamp, covers it with a container or puts it under a bed; but puts it on a stand, that those who enter in may see the light. ¹⁷For nothing is hidden that will not be revealed, nor anything secret that will not be known and come to light. ¹⁸Be careful therefore how you hear. For whoever has, to him will be given; and whoever doesn't have, from him will be taken away even that which he thinks he has." ¹⁹His mother and brothers came to him, and they could not come near him for the crowd. ²⁰Some people told him,

"Your mother and your brothers stand outside, desiring to see you." ²¹But he answered them, "My mother and my brothers are these who hear the word of God and do it." ²²Now on one of those days, he entered into a boat, himself and his disciples, and he said to them, "Let's go over to the other side of the lake." So they launched out. ²³But as they sailed, he fell asleep. A wind storm came down on the lake, and they were taking on dangerous amounts of water. ²⁴They came to him and awoke him, saying, "Master, Master, we are dying!" He awoke and rebuked the wind and the raging of the water; then they ceased, and it was calm. ²⁵He said to them, "Where is your faith?" Being afraid, they marveled, saying to one another, "Who is this then, that he commands even the winds and the water, and they obey him?" ²⁶Then they arrived at the country of the Gadarenes, which is opposite Galilee. ²⁷When Yeshua stepped ashore, a certain man out of the city who had demons for a long time met him. He wore no clothes, and didn't live in a house, but in the tombs. ²⁸When he saw Yeshua, he cried out and fell down before him, and with a loud voice said, "What do I have to do with you, Yeshua, you Son of the Most High God? I beg you, don't torment me!" ²⁹For Yeshua was commanding the unclean spirit to come out of the man. For the unclean spirit had often seized the man. He was kept under guard and bound with chains and fetters. Breaking the bonds apart, he was driven by the demon into the desert. ³⁰Yeshua asked him, "What is your name?" He said, "Legion," for many demons had entered into him. ³¹They begged him that he would not command them to go into the abyss. ³²Now there was there a herd of many pigs feeding on the mountain, and they begged him that he would allow them to enter into those. Then he allowed them. ³³The demons came out of the man and entered into the pigs, and the herd rushed down the steep bank into the lake and were drowned. ³⁴When those who fed them saw what had happened, they fled and told it in the city and in the country. ³⁵People went out to see what had happened. They came to Yeshua and found the man from whom the demons had gone out, sitting at Yeshua's feet, clothed and in his right mind; and they were afraid. ³⁶Those who saw it told them how he who had been possessed by demons was healed. ³⁷All the people of the surrounding country of the Gadarenes asked him to depart from them, for they were very much afraid. Then he entered into the boat and returned. ³⁸But the man from whom the demons had gone out begged him that he might go with him, but Yeshua sent him away, saying, ³⁹"Return to your house, and declare what great things God has done for you." He went his way, proclaiming throughout the whole city what great things Yeshua had done for him. ⁴⁰When Yeshua returned, the multitude welcomed him, for they were all waiting for him. ⁴¹Behold, a man named Jairus came. He was a ruler of the synagogue. He fell down at Yeshua's feet and begged him

^{xv}TR reads "him" instead of "them"

to come into his house, ⁴²for he had an only born ^{xvi} daughter, about twelve years of age, and she was dying. But as he went, the multitudes pressed against him. ⁴³A woman who had a flow of blood for twelve years, who had spent all her living on physicians and could not be healed by any, ⁴⁴came behind him and touched the fringe ^{xvii} of his cloak. Immediately the flow of her blood stopped. ⁴⁵Yeshua said, “Who touched me?” When all denied it, Peter and those with him said, “Master, the multitudes press and jostle you, and you say, ‘Who touched me?’” ⁴⁶But Yeshua said, “Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me.” ⁴⁷When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling; and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately. ⁴⁸He said to her, “Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.” ⁴⁹While he still spoke, one from the ruler of the synagogue’s house came, saying to him, “Your daughter is dead. Don’t trouble the Rabbi.” ⁵⁰But Yeshua hearing it, answered him, “Don’t be afraid. Only believe, and she will be healed.” ⁵¹When he came to the house, he didn’t allow anyone to enter in, except Peter, Yochanan, Jacob, the father of the child, and her mother. ⁵²All were weeping and mourning her, but he said, “Don’t weep. She isn’t dead, but sleeping.” ⁵³They were ridiculing him, knowing that she was dead. ⁵⁴But he put them all outside, and taking her by the hand, he called, saying, “Child, arise!” ⁵⁵Her spirit returned, and she rose up immediately. He commanded that something be given to her to eat. ⁵⁶Her parents were amazed, but he commanded them to tell no one what had been done.

⁹He called the twelve ^{xviii} together and gave them power and authority over all demons, and to cure diseases. ²He sent them out to proclaim God’s Kingdom and to heal the sick. ³He said to them, “Take nothing for your journey—no staffs, nor wallet, nor bread, nor money. Don’t have two tunics each. ⁴Into whatever house you enter, stay there, and depart from there. ⁵As many as don’t receive you, when you depart from that city, shake off even the dust from your feet for a testimony against them.” ⁶They departed and went throughout the villages, proclaiming the Good News and healing everywhere. ⁷Now Herod the tetrarch heard of all that was done by him; and he was very perplexed, because it was said by some that Yochanan had risen from the dead, ⁸and by some that Elijah had appeared, and by others that one of the old prophets had risen again. ⁹Herod said, “I beheaded Yochanan, but who is this about whom I hear such things?” He sought to see him. ¹⁰The emissaries, when they had returned, told

him what things they had done. He took them and withdrew apart to a desert region of ^{xix} a city called Bethsaida. ¹¹But the multitudes, perceiving it, followed him. He welcomed them, spoke to them of God’s Kingdom, and he cured those who needed healing. ¹²The day began to wear away; and the twelve came and said to him, “Send the multitude away, that they may go into the surrounding villages and farms and lodge and get food, for we are here in a deserted place.” ¹³But he said to them, “You give them something to eat.” They said, “We have no more than five loaves and two fish, unless we should go and buy food for all these people.” ¹⁴For they were about five thousand men. He said to his disciples, “Make them sit down in groups of about fifty each.” ¹⁵They did so, and made them all sit down. ¹⁶He took the five loaves and the two fish, and looking up to the sky, he blessed them, broke them, and gave them to the disciples to set before the multitude. ¹⁷They ate and were all filled. They gathered up twelve baskets of broken pieces that were left over. ¹⁸As he was praying alone, the disciples were near him, and he asked them, “Who do the multitudes say that I am?” ¹⁹They answered, “‘Yochanan the Immerser,’ but others say, ‘Elijah,’ and others, that one of the old prophets has risen again.” ²⁰He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered, “The Messiah of God.” ²¹But he warned them and commanded them to tell this to no one, ²²saying, “The Son of Man must suffer many things, and be rejected by the elders, chief priests, and scribes, and be killed, and the third day be raised up.” ²³He said to all, “If anyone desires to come after me, let him deny himself, take up his cross, ^{xx} and follow me. ²⁴For whoever desires to save his life will lose it, but whoever will lose his life for my sake will save it. ²⁵For what does it profit a man if he gains the whole world, and loses or forfeits his own self? ²⁶For whoever will be ashamed of me and of my words, of him will the Son of Man be ashamed when he comes in his glory, and the glory of the Father, and of the holy angels. ²⁷But I tell you the truth: There are some of those who stand here who will in no way taste of death until they see God’s Kingdom.” ²⁸About eight days after these sayings, he took with him Peter, Yochanan, and Jacob, and went up onto the mountain to pray. ²⁹As he was praying, the appearance of his face was altered, and his clothing became white and dazzling. ³⁰Behold, two men were talking with him, who were Moses and Elijah, ³¹who appeared in glory and spoke of his departure, ^{xxi} which he was about to accomplish at Jerusalem. ³²Now Peter and those who were with him were heavy with sleep, but when they were fully awake, they saw his glory, and the two men who stood with him. ³³As they were parting from him, Peter said to Yeshua, “Master, it is good for

^{xvi}The phrase “only born” is from the Greek word “*monogenēs*”, which is sometimes translated “only begotten” or “one and only.”

^{xvii}or, tassel

^{xviii}TR reads “his twelve disciples” instead of “the twelve”

^{xix}NU omits “a desert region of”.

^{xx}TR, NU add “daily”

^{xxi}literally, “exodus”

us to be here. Let's make three tents: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah," not knowing what he said. ³⁴While he said these things, a cloud came and overshadowed them, and they were afraid as they entered into the cloud. ³⁵A voice came out of the cloud, saying, "This is my beloved Son. Listen to him!" ³⁶When the voice came, Yeshua was found alone. They were silent, and told no one in those days any of the things which they had seen. ³⁷On the next day, when they had come down from the mountain, a great multitude met him. ³⁸Behold, a man from the crowd called out, saying, "Rabbi, I beg you to look at my son, for he is my only born ^{xxii} child. ³⁹Behold, a spirit takes him, he suddenly cries out, and it convulses him so that he foams; and it hardly departs from him, bruising him severely. ⁴⁰I begged your disciples to cast it out, and they couldn't." ⁴¹Yeshua answered, "Faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you and bear with you? Bring your son here." ⁴²While he was still coming, the demon threw him down and convulsed him violently. But Yeshua rebuked the unclean spirit, healed the boy, and gave him back to his father. ⁴³They were all astonished at the majesty of God. But while all were marveling at all the things which Yeshua did, he said to his disciples, ⁴⁴"Let these words sink into your ears, for the Son of Man will be delivered up into the hands of men." ⁴⁵But they didn't understand this saying. It was concealed from them, that they should not perceive it, and they were afraid to ask him about this saying. ⁴⁶An argument arose among them about which of them was the greatest. ⁴⁷Yeshua, perceiving the reasoning of their hearts, took a little child, and set him by his side, ⁴⁸and said to them, "Whoever receives this little child in my name receives me. Whoever receives me receives him who sent me. For whoever is least among you all, this one will be great." ⁴⁹Yochanan answered, "Master, we saw someone casting out demons in your name, and we forbade him, because he doesn't follow with us." ⁵⁰Yeshua said to him, "Don't forbid him, for he who is not against us is for us." ⁵¹It came to pass, when the days were near that he should be taken up, he intently set his face to go to Jerusalem ⁵²and sent messengers before his face. They went and entered into a village of the Samaritans, so as to prepare for him. ⁵³They didn't receive him, because he was traveling with his face set toward Jerusalem. ⁵⁴When his disciples, Jacob and Yochanan, saw this, they said, "Lord, do you want us to command fire to come down from the sky and destroy them, just as Elijah did?" ⁵⁵But he turned and rebuked them, "You don't know of what kind of spirit you are. ⁵⁶For the Son of Man didn't come to destroy men's lives, but to save them." They went to another village. ⁵⁷As they went on the way, a certain man said to him, "I want to follow you wherever you go, Lord." ⁵⁸Yeshua said to him,

"The foxes have holes and the birds of the sky have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to lay his head." ⁵⁹He said to another, "Follow me!" But he said, "Lord, allow me first to go and bury my father." ⁶⁰But Yeshua said to him, "Leave the dead to bury their own dead, but you go and announce God's Kingdom." ⁶¹Another also said, "I want to follow you, Lord, but first allow me to say good-bye to those who are at my house." ⁶²But Yeshua said to him, "No one, having put his hand to the plow and looking back, is fit for God's Kingdom."

¹⁰Now after these things, the Lord also appointed seventy others, and sent them two by two ahead of him ^{xxiii} into every city and place where he was about to come. ²Then he said to them, "The harvest is indeed plentiful, but the laborers are few. Pray therefore to the Lord of the harvest, that he may send out laborers into his harvest. ³Go your ways. Behold, I send you out as lambs among wolves. ⁴Carry no purse, nor wallet, nor sandals. Greet no one on the way. ⁵Into whatever house you enter, first say, 'Peace be to this house.' ⁶If a son of peace is there, your peace will rest on him; but if not, it will return to you. ⁷Remain in that same house, eating and drinking the things they give, for the laborer is worthy of his wages. Don't go from house to house. ⁸Into whatever city you enter and they receive you, eat the things that are set before you. ⁹Heal the sick who are there and tell them, 'God's Kingdom has come near to you.' ¹⁰But into whatever city you enter and they don't receive you, go out into its streets and say, ¹¹'Even the dust from your city that clings to us, we wipe off against you. Nevertheless know this, that God's Kingdom has come near to you.' ¹²I tell you, it will be more tolerable in that day for Sodom than for that city. ¹³"Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the mighty works had been done in Tyre and Sidon which were done in you, they would have repented long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes. ¹⁴But it will be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon in the judgment than for you. ¹⁵You, Capernaum, who are exalted to heaven, will be brought down to Sheol. ^{xxiv} ¹⁶Whoever listens to you listens to me, and whoever rejects you rejects me. Whoever rejects me rejects him who sent me." ¹⁷The seventy returned with joy, saying, "Lord, even the demons are subject to us in your name!" ¹⁸He said to them, "I saw Satan having fallen like lightning from heaven. ¹⁹Behold, I give you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy. Nothing will in any way hurt you. ²⁰Nevertheless, don't rejoice in this, that the spirits are subject to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven." ²¹In that same hour, Yeshua rejoiced in the Holy Spirit, and said, "I thank you, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that you have hidden these things

^{xxii}The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μόνος", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

^{xxiii}literally, "before his face"

^{xxiv}Sheol is the lower realm of the dead, or Hell.

from the wise and understanding, and revealed them to little children. Yes, Father, for so it was well-pleasing in your sight.” ²²Turning to the disciples, he said, “All things have been delivered to me by my Father. No one knows who the Son is, except the Father, and who the Father is, except the Son, and he to whomever the Son desires to reveal him.” ²³Turning to the disciples, he said privately, “Blessed are the eyes which see the things that you see, ²⁴for I tell you that many prophets and kings desired to see the things which you see, and didn’t see them, and to hear the things which you hear, and didn’t hear them.” ²⁵Behold, a certain Torah scholar stood up and tested him, saying, “Rabbi, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?” ²⁶He said to him, “What is written in the Torah? How do you read it?” ²⁷He answered, “You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your strength, and with all your mind; and your neighbor as yourself.” ²⁸He said to him, “You have answered correctly. Do this, and you will live.” ²⁹But he, desiring to justify himself, asked Yeshua, “Who is my neighbor?” ³⁰Yeshua answered, “A certain man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and he fell among robbers, who both stripped him and beat him, and departed, leaving him half dead. ³¹By chance a certain priest was going down that way. When he saw him, he passed by on the other side. ³²In the same way a Levite also, when he came to the place and saw him, passed by on the other side. ³³But a certain Samaritan, as he traveled, came where he was. When he saw him, he was moved with compassion, ³⁴came to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. He set him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him. ³⁵On the next day, when he departed, he took out two denarii, gave them to the host, and said to him, ‘Take care of him. Whatever you spend beyond that, I will repay you when I return.’ ³⁶Now which of these three do you think seemed to be a neighbor to him who fell among the robbers?” ³⁷He said, “He who showed mercy on him.” Then Yeshua said to him, “Go and do likewise.” ³⁸As they went on their way, he entered into a certain village, and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house. ³⁹She had a sister called Miriam, who also sat at Yeshua’s feet and heard his word. ⁴⁰But Martha was distracted with much serving, and she came up to him, and said, “Lord, don’t you care that my sister left me to serve alone? Ask her therefore to help me.” ⁴¹Yeshua answered her, “Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things, ⁴²but one thing is needed. Miriam has chosen the good part, which will not be taken away from her.”

11When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as Yochanan also taught his disciples.” ²He said to them, “When you pray, say, ‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy. May your Kingdom come. May your

will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. ³Give us day by day our daily bread. ⁴Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us. Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’” ⁵He said to them, “Which of you, if you go to a friend at midnight and tell him, ‘Friend, lend me three loaves of bread, ⁶for a friend of mine has come to me from a journey, and I have nothing to set before him,’ ⁷and he from within will answer and say, ‘Don’t bother me. The door is now shut, and my children are with me in bed. I can’t get up and give it to you’? ⁸I tell you, although he will not rise and give it to him because he is his friend, yet because of his persistence, he will get up and give him as many as he needs. ⁹“I tell you, keep asking, and it will be given you. Keep seeking, and you will find. Keep knocking, and it will be opened to you. ¹⁰For everyone who asks receives. He who seeks finds. To him who knocks it will be opened. ¹¹“Which of you fathers, if your son asks for bread, will give him a stone? Or if he asks for a fish, he won’t give him a snake instead of a fish, will he? ¹²Or if he asks for an egg, he won’t give him a scorpion, will he? ¹³If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him?” ¹⁴He was casting out a demon, and it was mute. When the demon had gone out, the mute man spoke; and the multitudes marveled. ¹⁵But some of them said, “He casts out demons by Beelzebul, the prince of the demons.” ¹⁶Others, testing him, sought from him a sign from heaven. ¹⁷But he, knowing their thoughts, said to them, “Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation. A house divided against itself falls. ¹⁸If Satan also is divided against himself, how will his kingdom stand? For you say that I cast out demons by Beelzebul. ¹⁹But if I cast out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your children cast them out? Therefore they will be your judges. ²⁰But if I by God’s finger cast out demons, then God’s Kingdom has come to you. ²¹“When the strong man, fully armed, guards his own dwelling, his goods are safe. ²²But when someone stronger attacks him and overcomes him, he takes from him his whole armor in which he trusted, and divides his plunder. ²³“He who is not with me is against me. He who doesn’t gather with me scatters. ²⁴The unclean spirit, when he has gone out of the man, passes through dry places, seeking rest; and finding none, he says, ‘I will turn back to my house from which I came out.’ ²⁵When he returns, he finds it swept and put in order. ²⁶Then he goes and takes seven other spirits more evil than himself, and they enter in and dwell there. The last state of that man becomes worse than the first.” ²⁷It came to pass, as he said these things, a certain woman out of the multitude lifted up her voice and said to him, “Blessed is the womb that bore you, and the breasts which nursed you!” ²⁸But he said, “On the contrary, blessed are those who hear the word of God, and keep it.” ²⁹When the multitudes were

gathering together to him, he began to say, "This is an evil generation. It seeks after a sign. No sign will be given to it but the sign of Jonah the prophet. ³⁰For even as Jonah became a sign to the Ninevites, so the Son of Man will also be to this generation. ³¹The Queen of the South will rise up in the judgment with the men of this generation and will condemn them, for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and behold, one greater than Solomon is here. ³²The men of Nineveh will stand up in the judgment with this generation, and will condemn it, for they repented at the proclaiming of Jonah; and behold, one greater than Jonah is here. ³³"No one, when he has lit a lamp, puts it in a cellar or under a basket, but on a stand, that those who come in may see the light. ³⁴The lamp of the body is the eye. Therefore when your eye is good, your whole body is also full of light; but when it is evil, your body also is full of darkness. ³⁵Therefore see whether the light that is in you isn't darkness. ³⁶If therefore your whole body is full of light, having no part dark, it will be wholly full of light, as when the lamp with its bright shining gives you light." ³⁷Now as he spoke, a certain Pharisee asked him to dine with him. He went in and sat at the table. ³⁸When the Pharisee saw it, he marveled that he had not first washed himself before dinner. ³⁹The Lord said to him, "Now you Pharisees cleanse the outside of the cup and of the platter, but your inward part is full of extortion and wickedness. ⁴⁰You foolish ones, didn't he who made the outside make the inside also? ⁴¹But give for gifts to the needy those things which are within, and behold, all things will be clean to you. ⁴²But woe to you Pharisees! For you tithe mint and rue and every herb, but you bypass justice and God's love. You ought to have done these, and not to have left the other undone. ⁴³Woe to you Pharisees! For you love the best seats in the synagogues and the greetings in the marketplaces. ⁴⁴Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like hidden graves, and the men who walk over them don't know it." ⁴⁵One of the Torah scholars answered him, "Rabbi, in saying this you insult us also." ⁴⁶He said, "Woe to you Torah scholars also! For you load men with burdens that are difficult to carry, and you yourselves won't even lift one finger to help carry those burdens. ⁴⁷Woe to you! For you build the tombs of the prophets, and your fathers killed them. ⁴⁸So you testify and consent to the works of your fathers. For they killed them, and you build their tombs. ⁴⁹Therefore also the wisdom of God said, 'I will send to them prophets and emissaries; and some of them they will kill and persecute, ⁵⁰that the blood of all the prophets, which was shed from the foundation of the world, may be required of this generation, ⁵¹from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, who perished between the altar and the sanctuary.' Yes, I tell you, it will be required of this generation. ⁵²Woe to you Torah scholars! For you took away the key of knowledge. You didn't enter in yourselves, and those who were

entering in, you hindered." ⁵³As he said these things to them, the scribes and the Pharisees began to be terribly angry, and to draw many things out of him, ⁵⁴lying in wait for him, and seeking to catch him in something he might say, that they might accuse him.

12Meanwhile, when a multitude of many thousands had gathered together, so much so that they trampled on each other, he began to tell his disciples first of all, "Beware of the yeast of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy. ²But there is nothing covered up that will not be revealed, nor hidden that will not be known. ³Therefore whatever you have said in the darkness will be heard in the light. What you have spoken in the ear in the inner rooms will be proclaimed on the housetops. ⁴"I tell you, my friends, don't be afraid of those who kill the body, and after that have no more that they can do. ⁵But I will warn you whom you should fear. Fear him who after he has killed, has power to cast into Gehinnom. ^{xxv} Yes, I tell you, fear him. ⁶"Aren't five sparrows sold for two assaria coins ^{xxvi}? Not one of them is forgotten by God. ⁷But the very hairs of your head are all counted. Therefore don't be afraid. You are of more value than many sparrows. ⁸"I tell you, everyone who confesses me before men, the Son of Man will also confess before the angels of God; ⁹but he who denies me in the presence of men will be denied in the presence of God's angels. ¹⁰Everyone who speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but those who blaspheme against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven. ¹¹When they bring you before the synagogues, the rulers, and the authorities, don't be anxious how or what you will answer or what you will say; ¹²for the Holy Spirit will teach you in that same hour what you must say." ¹³One of the multitude said to him, "Rabbi, tell my brother to divide the inheritance with me." ¹⁴But he said to him, "Man, who made me a judge or an arbitrator over you?" ¹⁵He said to them, "Beware! Keep yourselves from covetousness, for a man's life doesn't consist of the abundance of the things which he possesses." ¹⁶He spoke a parable to them, saying, "The ground of a certain rich man produced abundantly. ¹⁷He reasoned within himself, saying, 'What will I do, because I don't have room to store my crops?' ¹⁸He said, 'This is what I will do. I will pull down my barns, build bigger ones, and there I will store all my grain and my goods. ¹⁹I will tell my soul, 'Soul, you have many goods laid up for many years. Take your ease, eat, drink, and be merry.'" ²⁰But God said to him, 'You foolish one, tonight your soul is required of you. The things which you have prepared—whose will they be?' ²¹So is he who lays up treasure for himself, and is not rich toward God." ²²He said to his disciples, "Therefore I tell you, don't be

^{xxv}or, Hell

^{xxvi}An assarion was a small copper coin worth about an hour's wages for an agricultural laborer.

anxious for your life, what you will eat, nor yet for your body, what you will wear. ²³Life is more than food, and the body is more than clothing. ²⁴Consider the ravens: they don't sow, they don't reap, they have no warehouse or barn, and God feeds them. How much more valuable are you than birds! ²⁵Which of you by being anxious can add a cubit ^{xxvii} to his height? ²⁶If then you aren't able to do even the least things, why are you anxious about the rest? ²⁷Consider the lilies, how they grow. They don't toil, neither do they spin; yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these. ²⁸But if this is how God clothes the grass in the field, which today exists and tomorrow is cast into the oven, how much more will he clothe you, O you of little faith? ²⁹" Don't seek what you will eat or what you will drink; neither be anxious. ³⁰For the nations of the world seek after all of these things, but your Father knows that you need these things. ³¹But seek God's Kingdom, and all these things will be added to you. ³²" Don't be afraid, little flock, for it is your Father's good pleasure to give you the Kingdom. ³³Sell what you have and give gifts to the needy. Make for yourselves purses which don't grow old, a treasure in the heavens that doesn't fail, where no thief approaches and no moth destroys. ³⁴For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also. ³⁵" Let your waist be dressed and your lamps burning. ³⁶Be like men watching for their lord when he returns from the wedding feast, that when he comes and knocks, they may immediately open to him. ³⁷Blessed are those servants whom the lord will find watching when he comes. Most certainly I tell you that he will dress himself, make them recline, and will come and serve them. ³⁸They will be blessed if he comes in the second or third watch and finds them so. ³⁹But know this, that if the master of the house had known in what hour the thief was coming, he would have watched and not allowed his house to be broken into. ⁴⁰Therefore be ready also, for the Son of Man is coming in an hour that you don't expect him." ⁴¹Peter said to him, "Lord, are you telling this parable to us, or to everybody?" ⁴²The Lord said, "Who then is the faithful and wise steward, whom his lord will set over his household, to give them their portion of food at the right times? ⁴³Blessed is that servant whom his lord will find doing so when he comes. ⁴⁴Truly I tell you that he will set him over all that he has. ⁴⁵But if that servant says in his heart, 'My lord delays his coming,' and begins to beat the menservants and the maidservants, and to eat and drink and to be drunken, ⁴⁶then the lord of that servant will come in a day when he isn't expecting him and in an hour that he doesn't know, and will cut him in two, and place his portion with the unfaithful. ⁴⁷That servant who knew his lord's will, and didn't prepare nor do what he wanted, will be beaten with many stripes, ⁴⁸but he who didn't know,

^{xxvii}A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

and did things worthy of stripes, will be beaten with few stripes. To whomever much is given, of him will much be required; and to whom much was entrusted, of him more will be asked. ⁴⁹" I came to throw fire on the earth. I wish it were already kindled. ⁵⁰But I have an immersion to be immersed with, and how distressed I am until it is accomplished! ⁵¹Do you think that I have come to give peace in the earth? I tell you, no, but rather division. ⁵²For from now on, there will be five in one house divided, three against two, and two against three. ⁵³They will be divided, father against son, and son against father; mother against daughter, and daughter against her mother; mother-in-law against her daughter-in-law, and daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law." ⁵⁴He said to the multitudes also, "When you see a cloud rising from the west, immediately you say, 'A shower is coming,' and so it happens. ⁵⁵When a south wind blows, you say, 'There will be a scorching heat,' and it happens. ⁵⁶You hypocrites! You know how to interpret the appearance of the earth and the sky, but how is it that you don't interpret this time? ⁵⁷" Why don't you judge for yourselves what is right? ⁵⁸For when you are going with your adversary before the magistrate, try diligently on the way to be released from him, lest perhaps he drag you to the judge, and the judge deliver you to the officer, and the officer throw you into prison. ⁵⁹I tell you, you will by no means get out of there until you have paid the very last penny. ^{xxviii} "

13Now there were some present at the same time who told him about the Galileans whose blood Pilate had mixed with their sacrifices. ²Yeshua answered them, "Do you think that these Galileans were worse sinners than all the other Galileans, because they suffered such things? ³I tell you, no, but unless you repent, you will all perish in the same way. ⁴Or those eighteen on whom the tower in Siloam fell and killed them—do you think that they were worse offenders than all the men who dwell in Jerusalem? ⁵I tell you, no, but, unless you repent, you will all perish in the same way." ⁶He spoke this parable. "A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard, and he came seeking fruit on it and found none. ⁷He said to the vine dresser, 'Behold, these three years I have come looking for fruit on this fig tree, and found none. Cut it down! Why does it waste the soil?' ⁸He answered, 'Lord, leave it alone this year also, until I dig around it and fertilize it. ⁹If it bears fruit, fine; but if not, after that, you can cut it down.'" ¹⁰He was teaching in one of the synagogues on the Sabbath day. ¹¹Behold, there was a woman who had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years. She was bent over and could in no way straighten herself up. ¹²When Yeshua saw her, he called

^{xxviii}literally, lepton. A lepton is a very small brass Jewish coin worth half a Roman quadrans each, which is worth a quarter of the copper assarion. Lepta are worth less than 1% of an agricultural worker's daily wages.

her and said to her, “Woman, you are freed from your infirmity.” ¹³He laid his hands on her, and immediately she stood up straight and glorified God. ¹⁴The ruler of the synagogue, being indignant because Yeshua had healed on the Sabbath, said to the multitude, “There are six days in which men ought to work. Therefore come on those days and be healed, and not on the Sabbath day!” ¹⁵Therefore the Lord answered him, “You hypocrites! Doesn’t each one of you free his ox or his donkey from the stall on the Sabbath and lead him away to water?” ¹⁶Ought not this woman, being a daughter of Abraham whom Satan had bound eighteen long years, be freed from this bondage on the Sabbath day?” ¹⁷As he said these things, all his adversaries were disappointed; and all the multitude rejoiced for all the glorious things that were done by him. ¹⁸He said, “What is God’s Kingdom like? To what shall I compare it? ¹⁹It is like a grain of mustard seed which a man took and put in his own garden. It grew and became a large tree, and the birds of the sky live in its branches.” ²⁰Again he said, “To what shall I compare God’s Kingdom? ²¹It is like yeast, which a woman took and hid in three measures ^{xxix} of flour, until it was all leavened.” ²²He went on his way through cities and villages, teaching, and traveling on to Jerusalem. ²³One said to him, “Lord, are they few who are saved?” He said to them, ²⁴“Strive to enter in by the narrow door, for many, I tell you, will seek to enter in and will not be able. ²⁵When once the master of the house has risen up and has shut the door, and you begin to stand outside and to knock at the door, saying, ‘Lord, Lord, open to us!’ then he will answer and tell you, ‘I don’t know you or where you come from.’ ²⁶Then you will begin to say, ‘We ate and drank in your presence, and you taught in our streets.’ ²⁷He will say, ‘I tell you, I don’t know where you come from. Depart from me, all you workers of iniquity.’ ²⁸There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth when you see Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and all the prophets in God’s Kingdom, and yourselves being thrown outside. ²⁹They will come from the east, west, north, and south, and will sit down in God’s Kingdom. ³⁰Behold, there are some who are last who will be first, and there are some who are first who will be last.” ³¹On that same day, some Pharisees came, saying to him, “Get out of here and go away, for Herod wants to kill you.” ³²He said to them, “Go and tell that fox, ‘Behold, I cast out demons and perform cures today and tomorrow, and the third day I complete my mission. ³³Nevertheless I must go on my way today and tomorrow and the next day, for it can’t be that a prophet would perish outside of Jerusalem.’ ³⁴“Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I wanted to gather your children together, like a hen gathers her own brood under her wings, and you refused! ³⁵Behold, your house is left to

you desolate. I tell you, you will not see me until you say, ‘Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!’”

¹⁴When he went into the house of one of the rulers of the Pharisees on a Sabbath to eat bread, they were watching him. ²Behold, a certain man who had dropsy was in front of him. ³Yeshua, answering, spoke to the Torah scholars and Pharisees, saying, “Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath?” ⁴But they were silent. He took him, and healed him, and let him go. ⁵He answered them, “Which of you, if your son ^{xxx} or an ox fell into a well, wouldn’t immediately pull him out on a Sabbath day?” ⁶They couldn’t answer him regarding these things. ⁷He spoke a parable to those who were invited, when he noticed how they chose the best seats, and said to them, ⁸“When you are invited by anyone to a wedding feast, don’t sit in the best seat, since perhaps someone more honorable than you might be invited by him, ⁹and he who invited both of you would come and tell you, ‘Make room for this person.’ Then you would begin, with shame, to take the lowest place. ¹⁰But when you are invited, go and sit in the lowest place, so that when he who invited you comes, he may tell you, ‘Friend, move up higher.’ Then you will be honored in the presence of all who sit at the table with you. ¹¹For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted.” ¹²He also said to the one who had invited him, “When you make a dinner or a supper, don’t call your friends, nor your brothers, nor your kinsmen, nor rich neighbors, or perhaps they might also return the favor, and pay you back. ¹³But when you make a feast, ask the poor, the maimed, the lame, or the blind; ¹⁴and you will be blessed, because they don’t have the resources to repay you. For you will be repaid in the resurrection of the righteous.” ¹⁵When one of those who sat at the table with him heard these things, he said to him, “Blessed is he who will feast in God’s Kingdom!” ¹⁶But he said to him, “A certain man made a great supper, and he invited many people. ¹⁷He sent out his servant at supper time to tell those who were invited, ‘Come, for everything is ready now.’ ¹⁸They all as one began to make excuses.” The first said to him, ‘I have bought a field, and I must go and see it. Please have me excused.’ ¹⁹Another said, ‘I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I must go try them out. Please have me excused.’ ²⁰Another said, ‘I have married a wife, and therefore I can’t come.’ ²¹That servant came, and told his lord these things. Then the master of the house, being angry, said to his servant, ‘Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in the poor, maimed, blind, and lame.’ ²²The servant said, ‘Lord, it is done as you commanded, and there is still room.’ ²³The lord said to the servant, ‘Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled. ²⁴For I tell you that none of those men who were

^{xxix}literally, three sata. 3 sata is about 39 liters or a bit more than a bushel.

^{xxx}TR reads “donkey” instead of “son”

invited will taste of my supper.’” ²⁵Now great multitudes were going with him. He turned and said to them, ²⁶“If anyone comes to me, and doesn’t disregard ^{xxxi} his own father, mother, wife, children, brothers, and sisters, yes, and his own life also, he can’t be my disciple. ²⁷Whoever doesn’t bear his own cross and come after me, can’t be my disciple. ²⁸For which of you, desiring to build a tower, doesn’t first sit down and count the cost, to see if he has enough to complete it? ²⁹Or perhaps, when he has laid a foundation and isn’t able to finish, everyone who sees begins to mock him, ³⁰saying, ‘This man began to build and wasn’t able to finish.’ ³¹Or what king, as he goes to encounter another king in war, will not sit down first and consider whether he is able with ten thousand to meet him who comes against him with twenty thousand? ³²Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sends an envoy and asks for conditions of peace. ³³So therefore, whoever of you who doesn’t renounce all that he has, he can’t be my disciple. ³⁴“Salt is good, but if the salt becomes flat and tasteless, with what do you season it? ³⁵It is fit neither for the soil nor for the manure pile. It is thrown out. He who has ears to hear, let him hear.”

15Now all the tax collectors and sinners were coming close to him to hear him. ²The Pharisees and the scribes murmured, saying, “This man welcomes sinners, and eats with them.” ³He told them this parable: ⁴“Which of you men, if you had one hundred sheep and lost one of them, wouldn’t leave the ninety-nine in the wilderness and go after the one that was lost, until he found it? ⁵When he has found it, he carries it on his shoulders, rejoicing. ⁶When he comes home, he calls together his friends and his neighbors, saying to them, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found my sheep which was lost!’ ⁷I tell you that even so there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents, than over ninety-nine righteous people who need no repentance. ⁸“Or what woman, if she had ten drachma ^{xxxii} coins, if she lost one drachma coin, wouldn’t light a lamp, sweep the house, and seek diligently until she found it? ⁹When she has found it, she calls together her friends and neighbors, saying, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found the drachma which I had lost!’ ¹⁰Even so, I tell you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner repenting.” ¹¹He said, “A certain man had two sons. ¹²The younger of them said to his father, ‘Father, give me my share of your property.’ So he divided his livelihood between them. ¹³Not many days after, the younger son gathered all of this together and traveled into a far country. There he wasted his property with riotous living. ¹⁴When he had spent all of it, there arose a severe famine in that country, and he began to be in need. ¹⁵He went and joined himself to one of

the citizens of that country, and he sent him into his fields to feed pigs. ¹⁶He wanted to fill his belly with the pods that the pigs ate, but no one gave him any. ¹⁷But when he came to himself, he said, ‘How many hired servants of my father’s have bread enough to spare, and I’m dying with hunger! ¹⁸I will get up and go to my father, and will tell him, “Father, I have sinned against heaven and in your sight. ¹⁹I am no more worthy to be called your son. Make me as one of your hired servants.”’ ²⁰“He arose and came to his father. But while he was still far off, his father saw him and was moved with compassion, and ran, fell on his neck, and kissed him. ²¹The son said to him, ‘Father, I have sinned against heaven and in your sight. I am no longer worthy to be called your son.’ ²²“But the father said to his servants, ‘Bring out the best robe and put it on him. Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet. ²³Bring the fattened calf, kill it, and let’s eat and celebrate; ²⁴for this, my son, was dead and is alive again. He was lost and is found.’ Then they began to celebrate. ²⁵“Now his elder son was in the field. As he came near to the house, he heard music and dancing. ²⁶He called one of the servants to him and asked what was going on. ²⁷He said to him, ‘Your brother has come, and your father has killed the fattened calf, because he has received him back safe and healthy.’ ²⁸But he was angry and would not go in. Therefore his father came out and begged him. ²⁹But he answered his father, ‘Behold, these many years I have served you, and I never disobeyed a commandment of yours, but you never gave me a goat, that I might celebrate with my friends. ³⁰But when this your son came, who has devoured your living with prostitutes, you killed the fattened calf for him.’ ³¹“He said to him, ‘Son, you are always with me, and all that is mine is yours. ³²But it was appropriate to celebrate and be glad, for this, your brother, was dead, and is alive again. He was lost, and is found.’”

16He also said to his disciples, “There was a certain rich man who had a manager. An accusation was made to him that this man was wasting his possessions. ²He called him, and said to him, ‘What is this that I hear about you? Give an accounting of your management, for you can no longer be manager.’ ³“The manager said within himself, ‘What will I do, seeing that my lord is taking away the management position from me? I don’t have strength to dig. I am ashamed to beg. ⁴I know what I will do, so that when I am removed from management, they may receive me into their houses.’ ⁵Calling each one of his lord’s debtors to him, he said to the first, ‘How much do you owe to my lord?’ ⁶He said, ‘A hundred batos ^{xxxiii} of oil.’ He said to him, ‘Take your bill, and sit down quickly and write fifty.’ ⁷Then he said to another, ‘How much do you owe?’ He said, ‘A

^{xxxi}or, hate

^{xxxii}A drachma coin was worth about 2 days wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xxxiii}100 batos is about 395 liters or 104 U. S. gallons.

hundred cors ^{xxxiv} of wheat.' He said to him, 'Take your bill, and write eighty.' ⁸" His lord commended the dishonest manager because he had done wisely, for the children of this world are, in their own generation, wiser than the children of the light. ⁹I tell you, make for yourselves friends by means of unrighteous mammon, so that when you fail, they may receive you into the eternal tents. ¹⁰He who is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much. He who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much. ¹¹If therefore you have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches? ¹²If you have not been faithful in that which is another's, who will give you that which is your own? ¹³No servant can serve two masters, for either he will hate the one and love the other; or else he will hold to one and despise the other. You aren't able to serve God and Mammon." ^{xxxv} ¹⁴The Pharisees, who were lovers of money, also heard all these things, and they scoffed at him. ¹⁵He said to them, "You are those who justify yourselves in the sight of men, but God knows your hearts. For that which is exalted among men is an abomination in the sight of God. ¹⁶" The Torah and the Prophets were until Yochanan. From that time the Good News of God's Kingdom is preached, and everyone is forcing his way into it. ¹⁷But it is easier for heaven and earth to pass away than for one tiny stroke of a pen in the Torah to become void. ¹⁸" Everyone who divorces his wife and marries another commits adultery. He who marries one who is divorced from a husband commits adultery. ¹⁹" Now there was a certain rich man, and he was clothed in purple and fine linen, living in luxury every day. ²⁰A certain beggar, named Lazarus, was taken to his gate, full of sores, ²¹and desiring to be fed with the crumbs that fell from the rich man's table. Yes, even the dogs came and licked his sores. ²²The beggar died, and he was carried away by the angels to Abraham's bosom. The rich man also died and was buried. ²³In Sheol, ^{xxxvi} he lifted up his eyes, being in torment, and saw Abraham far off, and Lazarus at his bosom. ²⁴He cried and said, 'Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water and cool my tongue! For I am in anguish in this flame.' ²⁵" But Abraham said, 'Son, remember that you, in your lifetime, received your good things, and Lazarus, in the same way, bad things. But here he is now comforted and you are in anguish. ²⁶Besides all this, between us and you there is a great gulf fixed, that those who want to pass from here to you are not able, and that no one may cross over from there to us.' ²⁷" He said, 'I ask you therefore, father, that you would send him to my father's house—' ²⁸for I have five brothers—that he may testify to them, so they won't also come into this place of torment.' ²⁹" But Abraham said to

him, 'They have Moses and the Prophets. Let them listen to them.' ³⁰" He said, 'No, father Abraham, but if one goes to them from the dead, they will repent.' ³¹" He said to him, 'If they don't listen to Moses and the Prophets, neither will they be persuaded if one rises from the dead.'"

¹⁷He said to the disciples, "It is impossible that no occasions of stumbling should come, but woe to him through whom they come! ²It would be better for him if a millstone were hung around his neck, and he were thrown into the sea, rather than that he should cause one of these little ones to stumble. ³Be careful. If your brother sins against you, rebuke him. If he repents, forgive him. ⁴If he sins against you seven times in the day, and seven times returns, saying, 'I repent,' you shall forgive him." ⁵The emissaries said to the Lord, "Increase our faith." ⁶The Lord said, "If you had faith like a grain of mustard seed, you would tell this sycamore tree, 'Be uprooted and be planted in the sea,' and it would obey you. ⁷But who is there among you, having a servant plowing or keeping sheep, that will say when he comes in from the field, 'Come immediately and sit down at the table'? ⁸Wouldn't he rather tell him, 'Prepare my supper, clothe yourself properly, and serve me while I eat and drink. Afterward you shall eat and drink'? ⁹Does he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded? I think not. ¹⁰Even so you also, when you have done all the things that are commanded you, say, 'We are unworthy servants. We have done our duty.'" ¹¹As he was on his way to Jerusalem, he was passing along the borders of Samaria and Galilee. ¹²As he entered into a certain village, ten men who were lepers met him, who stood at a distance. ¹³They lifted up their voices, saying, "Yeshua, Master, have mercy on us!" ¹⁴When he saw them, he said to them, "Go and show yourselves to the priests." As they went, they were cleansed. ¹⁵One of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, glorifying God with a loud voice. ¹⁶He fell on his face at Yeshua's feet, giving him thanks; and he was a Samaritan. ¹⁷Yeshua answered, "Weren't the ten cleansed? But where are the nine? ¹⁸Were there none found who returned to give glory to God, except this foreigner?" ¹⁹Then he said to him, "Get up, and go your way. Your faith has healed you." ²⁰Being asked by the Pharisees when God's Kingdom would come, he answered them, "God's Kingdom doesn't come with observation; ²¹neither will they say, 'Look, here!' or 'Look, there!' for behold, God's Kingdom is within you." ²²He said to the disciples, "The days will come when you will desire to see one of the days of the Son of Man, and you will not see it. ²³They will tell you, 'Look, here!' or 'Look, there!' Don't go away or follow after them, ²⁴for as the lightning, when it flashes out of one part under the sky, shines to another part under the sky, so will the Son of Man be in his day. ²⁵But first, he must suffer many things and be rejected by

^{xxxiv}100 cors = about 2,110 liters or 600 bushels.

^{xxxv}"Mammon" refers to riches or a false god of wealth.

^{xxxvi}or, Hell

this generation. ²⁶As it was in the days of Noah, even so it will also be in the days of the Son of Man. ²⁷They ate, they drank, they married, and they were given in marriage until the day that Noah entered into the ship, and the flood came and destroyed them all. ²⁸Likewise, even as it was in the days of Lot: they ate, they drank, they bought, they sold, they planted, they built; ²⁹but in the day that Lot went out from Sodom, it rained fire and sulfur from the sky and destroyed them all. ³⁰It will be the same way in the day that the Son of Man is revealed. ³¹In that day, he who will be on the housetop and his goods in the house, let him not go down to take them away. Let him who is in the field likewise not turn back. ³²Remember Lot's wife! ³³Whoever seeks to save his life loses it, but whoever loses his life preserves it. ³⁴I tell you, in that night there will be two people in one bed. One will be taken and the other will be left. ³⁵There will be two grinding grain together. One will be taken and the other will be left." ^{36xxxvii} ³⁷They, answering, asked him, "Where, Lord?" He said to them, "Where the body is, there the vultures will also be gathered together."

18He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray and not give up, ²saying, "There was a judge in a certain city who didn't fear God and didn't respect man. ³A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, 'Defend me from my adversary!' ⁴He wouldn't for a while; but afterward he said to himself, 'Though I neither fear God nor respect man, ⁵yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.'" ⁶The Lord said, "Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷Won't God avenge his chosen ones who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?" ⁹He also spoke this parable to certain people who were convinced of their own righteousness, and who despised all others: ¹⁰"Two men went up into the temple to pray; one was a Pharisee, and the other was a tax collector. ¹¹The Pharisee stood and prayed by himself like this: 'God, I thank you that I am not like the rest of men: extortionists, unrighteous, adulterers, or even like this tax collector. ¹²I fast twice a week. I give tithes of all that I get.' ¹³But the tax collector, standing far away, wouldn't even lift up his eyes to heaven, but beat his breast, saying, 'God, be merciful to me, a sinner!' ¹⁴I tell you, this man went down to his house justified rather than the other; for everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, but he who humbles himself will be exalted." ¹⁵They were also bringing their babies to him, that he might touch them. But when the disciples saw it, they rebuked them. ¹⁶Yeshua summoned them, say-

xxxvii Some Greek manuscripts add: "Two will be in the field: the one taken, and the other left."

ing, "Allow the little children to come to me, and don't hinder them, for God's Kingdom belongs to such as these. ¹⁷Most certainly, I tell you, whoever doesn't receive God's Kingdom like a little child, he will in no way enter into it." ¹⁸A certain ruler asked him, saying, "Good Rabbi, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?" ¹⁹Yeshua asked him, "Why do you call me good? No one is good, except one: God. ²⁰You know the commandments: 'Don't commit adultery,' 'Don't murder,' 'Don't steal,' 'Don't give false testimony,' 'Honor your father and your mother.'" ²¹He said, "I have observed all these things from my youth up." ²²When Yeshua heard these things, he said to him, "You still lack one thing. Sell all that you have and distribute it to the poor. Then you will have treasure in heaven; then come, follow me." ²³But when he heard these things, he became very sad, for he was very rich. ²⁴Yeshua, seeing that he became very sad, said, "How hard it is for those who have riches to enter into God's Kingdom! ²⁵For it is easier for a camel to enter in through a needle's eye than for a rich man to enter into God's Kingdom." ²⁶Those who heard it said, "Then who can be saved?" ²⁷But he said, "The things which are impossible with men are possible with God." ²⁸Peter said, "Look, we have left everything and followed you." ²⁹He said to them, "Most certainly I tell you, there is no one who has left house, or wife, or brothers, or parents, or children, for God's Kingdom's sake, ³⁰who will not receive many times more in this time, and in the world to come, eternal life." ³¹He took the twelve aside and said to them, "Behold, we are going up to Jerusalem, and all the things that are written through the prophets concerning the Son of Man will be completed. ³²For he will be delivered up to the Gentiles, will be mocked, treated shamefully, and spit on. ³³They will scourge and kill him. On the third day, he will rise again." ³⁴They understood none of these things. This saying was hidden from them, and they didn't understand the things that were said. ³⁵As he came near Jericho, a certain blind man sat by the road, begging. ³⁶Hearing a multitude going by, he asked what this meant. ³⁷They told him that Yeshua of Nazareth was passing by. ³⁸He cried out, "Yeshua, you son of David, have mercy on me!" ³⁹Those who led the way rebuked him, that he should be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "You son of David, have mercy on me!" ⁴⁰Standing still, Yeshua commanded him to be brought to him. When he had come near, he asked him, ⁴¹"What do you want me to do?" He said, "Lord, that I may see again." ⁴²Yeshua said to him, "Receive your sight. Your faith has healed you." ⁴³Immediately he received his sight and followed him, glorifying God. All the people, when they saw it, praised God.

19He entered and was passing through Jericho. ²There was a man named Zacchaeus. He was a chief tax collector, and he was rich. ³He was trying to see who Yeshua

was, and couldn't because of the crowd, because he was short. ⁴He ran on ahead and climbed up into a sycamore tree to see him, for he was going to pass that way. ⁵When Yeshua came to the place, he looked up and saw him, and said to him, "Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for today I must stay at your house." ⁶He hurried, came down, and received him joyfully. ⁷When they saw it, they all murmured, saying, "He has gone in to lodge with a man who is a sinner." ⁸Zacchaeus stood and said to the Lord, "Behold, Lord, half of my goods I give to the poor. If I have wrongfully exacted anything of anyone, I restore four times as much." ⁹Yeshua said to him, "Today, salvation has come to this house, because he also is a son of Abraham. ¹⁰For the Son of Man came to seek and to save that which was lost." ¹¹As they heard these things, he went on and told a parable, because he was near Jerusalem, and they supposed that God's Kingdom would be revealed immediately. ¹²He said therefore, "A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom and to return. ¹³He called ten servants of his and gave them ten mina coins, ^{xxxviii} and told them, 'Conduct business until I come.' ¹⁴But his citizens hated him, and sent an envoy after him, saying, 'We don't want this man to reign over us.' ¹⁵" When he had come back again, having received the kingdom, he commanded these servants, to whom he had given the money, to be called to him, that he might know what they had gained by conducting business. ¹⁶The first came before him, saying, 'Lord, your mina has made ten more minas.' ¹⁷" He said to him, 'Well done, you good servant! Because you were found faithful with very little, you shall have authority over ten cities.' ¹⁸" The second came, saying, 'Your mina, Lord, has made five minas.' ¹⁹" So he said to him, 'And you are to be over five cities.' ²⁰Another came, saying, 'Lord, behold, your mina, which I kept laid away in a handkerchief, ²¹for I feared you, because you are an exacting man. You take up that which you didn't lay down, and reap that which you didn't sow.' ²²" He said to him, 'Out of your own mouth I will judge you, you wicked servant! You knew that I am an exacting man, taking up that which I didn't lay down and reaping that which I didn't sow. ²³Then why didn't you deposit my money in the bank, and at my coming, I might have earned interest on it?' ²⁴He said to those who stood by, 'Take the mina away from him and give it to him who has the ten minas.' ²⁵" They said to him, 'Lord, he has ten minas!' ²⁶" For I tell you that to everyone who has, will more be given; but from him who doesn't have, even that which he has will be taken away from him. ²⁷But bring those enemies of mine who didn't want me to reign over them here, and kill them before me.'" ²⁸Having said these things, he went on ahead, going up to Jerusalem. ²⁹When he came near

to Bethsphage ^{xxxix} and Bethany, at the mountain that is called Olivet, he sent two of his disciples, ³⁰saying, "Go your way into the village on the other side, in which, as you enter, you will find a colt tied, which no man has ever sat upon. Untie it and bring it. ³¹If anyone asks you, 'Why are you untying it?' say to him: 'The Lord needs it.'" ³²Those who were sent went away and found things just as he had told them. ³³As they were untying the colt, its owners said to them, "Why are you untying the colt?" ³⁴They said, "The Lord needs it." ³⁵Then they brought it to Yeshua. They threw their cloaks on the colt and sat Yeshua on them. ³⁶As he went, they spread their cloaks on the road. ³⁷As he was now getting near, at the descent of the Mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began to rejoice and praise God with a loud voice for all the mighty works which they had seen, ³⁸saying, "Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord! Peace in heaven, and glory in the highest!" ³⁹Some of the Pharisees from the multitude said to him, "Rabbi, rebuke your disciples!" ⁴⁰He answered them, "I tell you that if these were silent, the stones would cry out." ⁴¹When he came near, he saw the city and wept over it, ⁴²saying, "If you, even you, had known today the things which belong to your peace! But now, they are hidden from your eyes. ⁴³For the days will come on you when your enemies will throw up a barricade against you, surround you, hem you in on every side, ⁴⁴and will dash you and your children within you to the ground. They will not leave in you one stone on another, because you didn't know the time of your visitation." ⁴⁵He entered into the temple and began to drive out those who bought and sold in it, ⁴⁶saying to them, "It is written, 'My house is a house of prayer,' but you have made it a 'den of robbers!'" ⁴⁷He was teaching daily in the temple, but the chief priests, the scribes, and the leading men among the people sought to destroy him. ⁴⁸They couldn't find what they might do, for all the people hung on to every word that he said.

20On one of those days, as he was teaching the people in the temple and proclaiming the Good News, the ^{x1}priests and scribes came to him with the elders. ²They asked him, "Tell us: by what authority do you do these things? Or who is giving you this authority?" ³He answered them, "I also will ask you one question. Tell me: ⁴the immersion of Yochanan, was it from heaven, or from men?" ⁵They reasoned with themselves, saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will say, 'Why didn't you believe him?'" ⁶But if we say, 'From men,' all the people will stone us, for they are persuaded that Yochanan was a prophet." ⁷They answered that they didn't know where it was from. ⁸Yeshua said to them, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things." ⁹He began to tell the people

^{xxxviii}10 minas was more than 3 years' wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xxxix}TR, NU read "Bethpage" instead of "Bethsphage"

^{x1}TR adds "chief"

this parable: “A ^{xli} man planted a vineyard and rented it out to some farmers, and went into another country for a long time. ¹⁰At the proper season, he sent a servant to the farmers to collect his share of the fruit of the vineyard. But the farmers beat him and sent him away empty. ¹¹He sent yet another servant, and they also beat him and treated him shamefully, and sent him away empty. ¹²He sent yet a third, and they also wounded him and threw him out. ¹³The lord of the vineyard said, ‘What shall I do? I will send my beloved son. It may be that seeing him, they will respect him.’ ¹⁴“ But when the farmers saw him, they reasoned among themselves, saying, ‘This is the heir. Come, let’s kill him, that the inheritance may be ours.’ ¹⁵Then they threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. What therefore will the lord of the vineyard do to them? ¹⁶He will come and destroy these farmers, and will give the vineyard to others.” When they heard that, they said, “May that never be!” ¹⁷But he looked at them and said, “ Then what is this that is written, ‘ The stone which the builders rejected was made the chief cornerstone?’ ¹⁸Everyone who falls on that stone will be broken to pieces, but it will crush whomever it falls on to dust.” ¹⁹The chief priests and the scribes sought to lay hands on him that very hour, but they feared the people—for they knew he had spoken this parable against them. ²⁰They watched him and sent out spies, who pretended to be righteous, that they might trap him in something he said, so as to deliver him up to the power and authority of the governor. ²¹They asked him, “Rabbi, we know that you say and teach what is right, and aren’t partial to anyone, but truly teach the way of God. ²²Is it lawful for us to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?” ²³But he perceived their craftiness, and said to them, “Why do you test me? ²⁴Show me a denarius. Whose image and inscription are on it?” They answered, “Caesar’s.” ²⁵He said to them, “ Then give to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s.” ²⁶They weren’t able to trap him in his words before the people. They marveled at his answer and were silent. ²⁷Some of the Sadducees came to him, those who deny that there is a resurrection. ²⁸They asked him, “Rabbi, Moses wrote to us that if a man’s brother dies having a wife, and he is childless, his brother should take the wife and raise up children for his brother. ²⁹There were therefore seven brothers. The first took a wife, and died childless. ³⁰The second took her as wife, and he died childless. ³¹The third took her, and likewise the seven all left no children, and died. ³²Afterward the woman also died. ³³Therefore in the resurrection whose wife of them will she be? For the seven had her as a wife.” ³⁴Yeshua said to them, “ The children of this age marry and are given in marriage. ³⁵But those who are considered worthy to attain to that age and the resurrection from the dead neither marry nor are given in marriage. ³⁶For they can’t die any more, for they are like

the angels and are children of God, being children of the resurrection. ³⁷But that the dead are raised, even Moses showed at the bush, when he called the Lord ‘The God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.’ ³⁸Now he is not the God of the dead, but of the living, for all are alive to him.” ³⁹Some of the scribes answered, “Rabbi, you speak well.” ⁴⁰They didn’t dare to ask him any more questions. ⁴¹He said to them, “ Why do they say that the Messiah is David’s son? ⁴²David himself says in the scroll of Psalms, ‘ The Lord said to my Lord, “ Sit at my right hand, ⁴³until I make your enemies the footstool of your feet.”’ ⁴⁴“ David therefore calls him Lord, so how is he his son?” ⁴⁵In the hearing of all the people, he said to his disciples, ⁴⁶“ Beware of those scribes who like to walk in long robes, and love greetings in the marketplaces, the best seats in the synagogues, and the best places at feasts; ⁴⁷who devour widows’ houses, and for a pretense make long prayers. These will receive greater condemnation.”

²¹He looked up and saw the rich people who were putting their gifts into the treasury. ²He saw a certain poor widow casting in two small brass coins. ^{xlii} ³He said, “ Truly I tell you, this poor widow put in more than all of them, ⁴for all these put in gifts for God from their abundance, but she, out of her poverty, put in all that she had to live on.” ⁵As some were talking about the temple and how it was decorated with beautiful stones and gifts, he said, ⁶“ As for these things which you see, the days will come in which there will not be left here one stone on another that will not be thrown down.” ⁷They asked him, “Rabbi, so when will these things be? What is the sign that these things are about to happen?” ⁸He said, “Watch out that you don’t get led astray, for many will come in my name, saying, ‘I am he ^{xliii},’ and, ‘The time is at hand.’ Therefore don’t follow them. ⁹When you hear of wars and disturbances, don’t be terrified, for these things must happen first, but the end won’t come immediately.” ¹⁰Then he said to them, “ Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. ¹¹There will be great earthquakes, famines, and plagues in various places. There will be terrors and great signs from heaven. ¹²But before all these things, they will lay their hands on you and will persecute you, delivering you up to synagogues and prisons, bringing you before kings and governors for my name’s sake. ¹³It will turn out as a testimony for you. ¹⁴Settle it therefore in your hearts not to meditate beforehand how to answer, ¹⁵for I will give you a mouth and wisdom which all your adversaries will not be able to withstand or to contradict. ¹⁶You will be handed over even by parents, brothers, relatives, and friends. They will cause some of you to be put to death. ¹⁷You will be hated by all men for my name’s

^{xli}NU (in brackets) and TR add “certain”

^{xlii}literally, “two lepta.” 2 lepta was about 1% of a day’s wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xliii}or, I AM

sake. ¹⁸And not a hair of your head will perish. ¹⁹“By your endurance you will win your lives. ²⁰“But when you see Jerusalem surrounded by armies, then know that its desolation is at hand. ²¹Then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains. Let those who are in the middle of her depart. Let those who are in the country not enter therein. ²²For these are days of vengeance, that all things which are written may be fulfilled. ²³Woe to those who are pregnant and to those who nurse infants in those days! For there will be great distress in the land and wrath to this people. ²⁴They will fall by the edge of the sword, and will be led captive into all the nations. Jerusalem will be trampled down by the Gentiles until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled. ²⁵“There will be signs in the sun, moon, and stars; and on the earth anxiety of nations, in perplexity for the roaring of the sea and the waves; ²⁶men fainting for fear and for expectation of the things which are coming on the world, for the powers of the heavens will be shaken. ²⁷Then they will see the Son of Man coming in a cloud with power and great glory. ²⁸But when these things begin to happen, look up and lift up your heads, because your redemption is near.” ²⁹He told them a parable. “See the fig tree and all the trees. ³⁰When they are already budding, you see it and know by your own selves that the summer is already near. ³¹Even so you also, when you see these things happening, know that God’s Kingdom is near. ³²Most certainly I tell you, this generation will not pass away until all things are accomplished. ³³Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will by no means pass away. ³⁴“So be careful, or your hearts will be loaded down with carousing, drunkenness, and cares of this life, and that day will come on you suddenly. ³⁵For it will come like a snare on all those who dwell on the surface of all the earth. ³⁶Therefore be watchful all the time, praying that you may be counted worthy to escape all these things that will happen, and to stand before the Son of Man.” ³⁷Every day Yeshua was teaching in the temple, and every night he would go out and spend the night on the mountain that is called Olivet. ³⁸All the people came early in the morning to him in the temple to hear him.

22Now the feast of unleavened bread, which is called the Passover, was approaching. ²The chief priests and the scribes sought how they might put him to death, for they feared the people. ³Satan entered into Judah, who was also called Iscariot, who was counted with the twelve. ⁴He went away and talked with the chief priests and captains about how he might deliver him to them. ⁵They were glad, and agreed to give him money. ⁶He consented and sought an opportunity to deliver him to them in the absence of the multitude. ⁷The day of unleavened bread came, on which the Passover must be sacrificed. ⁸Yeshua sent Peter and Yochanan, saying, “Go and prepare the Passover for us, that we may eat.” ⁹They said to him, “Where do you

want us to prepare?” ¹⁰He said to them, “Behold, when you have entered into the city, a man carrying a pitcher of water will meet you. Follow him into the house which he enters. ¹¹Tell the master of the house, ‘The Rabbi says to you, “Where is the guest room, where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?”’” ¹²He will show you a large, furnished upper room. Make preparations there.” ¹³They went, found things as Yeshua had told them, and they prepared the Passover. ¹⁴When the hour had come, he sat down with the twelve emissaries. ¹⁵He said to them, “I have earnestly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer, ¹⁶for I tell you, I will no longer by any means eat of it until it is fulfilled in God’s Kingdom.” ¹⁷He received a cup, and when he had given thanks, he said, “Take this and share it among yourselves, ¹⁸for I tell you, I will not drink at all again from the fruit of the vine, until God’s Kingdom comes.” ¹⁹He took bread, and when he had given thanks, he broke and gave it to them, saying, “This is my body which is given for you. Do this in memory of me.” ²⁰Likewise, he took the cup after supper, saying, “This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you. ²¹But behold, the hand of him who betrays me is with me on the table. ²²The Son of Man indeed goes as it has been determined, but woe to that man through whom he is betrayed!” ²³They began to question among themselves which of them it was who would do this thing. ²⁴A dispute also arose among them, which of them was considered to be greatest. ²⁵He said to them, “The kings of the nations lord it over them, and those who have authority over them are called ‘benefactors.’ ²⁶But not so with you. Rather, the one who is greater among you, let him become as the younger, and one who is governing, as one who serves. ²⁷For who is greater, one who sits at the table, or one who serves? Isn’t it he who sits at the table? But I am among you as one who serves. ²⁸“But you are those who have continued with me in my trials. ²⁹I confer on you a kingdom, even as my Father conferred on me, ³⁰that you may eat and drink at my table in my Kingdom. You will sit on thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.” ³¹The Lord said, “Simon, Simon, behold, Satan asked to have all of you, that he might sift you as wheat, ³²but I prayed for you, that your faith wouldn’t fail. You, when once you have turned again, establish your brothers.” ^{xliv} ³³He said to him, “Lord, I am ready to go with you both to prison and to death!” ³⁴He said, “I tell you, Peter, the rooster will by no means crow today until you deny that you know me three times.” ³⁵He said to them, “When I sent you out without purse, bag, and sandals, did you lack anything?” They said, “Nothing.” ³⁶Then he said to them, “But now, whoever has a purse, let him take it, and likewise a bag. Whoever has none, let him sell his cloak, and buy a sword. ³⁷For I tell you that this which is written

^{xliv}The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

must still be fulfilled in me: 'He was counted with transgressors.' For that which concerns me is being fulfilled." ³⁸They said, "Lord, behold, here are two swords." He said to them, "That is enough." ³⁹He came out and went, as his custom was, to the Mount of Olives. His disciples also followed him. ⁴⁰When he was at the place, he said to them, "Pray that you don't enter into temptation." ⁴¹He was withdrawn from them about a stone's throw, and he knelt down and prayed, ⁴²saying, "Father, if you are willing, remove this cup from me. Nevertheless, not my will, but yours, be done." ⁴³An angel from heaven appeared to him, strengthening him. ⁴⁴Being in agony, he prayed more earnestly. His sweat became like great drops of blood falling down on the ground. ⁴⁵When he rose up from his prayer, he came to the disciples and found them sleeping because of grief, ⁴⁶and said to them, "Why do you sleep? Rise and pray that you may not enter into temptation." ⁴⁷While he was still speaking, a crowd appeared. He who was called Judah, one of the twelve, was leading them. He came near to Yeshua to kiss him. ⁴⁸But Yeshua said to him, "Judah, do you betray the Son of Man with a kiss?" ⁴⁹When those who were around him saw what was about to happen, they said to him, "Lord, shall we strike with the sword?" ⁵⁰A certain one of them struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his right ear. ⁵¹But Yeshua answered, "—Let me at least do this"—and he touched his ear and healed him. ⁵²Yeshua said to the chief priests, captains of the temple, and elders, who had come against him, "Have you come out as against a robber, with swords and clubs?" ⁵³When I was with you in the temple daily, you didn't stretch out your hands against me. But this is your hour, and the power of darkness." ⁵⁴They seized him and led him away, and brought him into the high priest's house. But Peter followed from a distance. ⁵⁵When they had kindled a fire in the middle of the courtyard and had sat down together, Peter sat among them. ⁵⁶A certain servant girl saw him as he sat in the light, and looking intently at him, said, "This man also was with him." ⁵⁷He denied Yeshua, saying, "Woman, I don't know him." ⁵⁸After a little while someone else saw him and said, "You also are one of them!" But Peter answered, "Man, I am not!" ⁵⁹After about one hour passed, another confidently affirmed, saying, "Truly this man also was with him, for he is a Galilean!" ⁶⁰But Peter said, "Man, I don't know what you are talking about!" Immediately, while he was still speaking, a rooster crowed. ⁶¹The Lord turned and looked at Peter. Then Peter remembered the Lord's word, how he said to him, "Before the rooster crows you will deny me three times." ⁶²He went out, and wept bitterly. ⁶³The men who held Yeshua mocked him and beat him. ⁶⁴Having blindfolded him, they struck him on the face and asked him, "Prophecy! Who is the one who struck you?" ⁶⁵They spoke many other things against him, insulting him. ⁶⁶As soon as it was day, the assembly of the elders of the people were gathered to-

gether, both chief priests and scribes, and they led him away into their council, saying, ⁶⁷"If you are the Messiah, tell us." But he said to them, "If I tell you, you won't believe, ⁶⁸and if I ask, you will in no way answer me or let me go. ⁶⁹From now on, the Son of Man will be seated at the right hand of the power of God." ⁷⁰They all said, "Are you then the Son of God?" He said to them, "You say it, because I am." ⁷¹They said, "Why do we need any more witness? For we ourselves have heard from his own mouth!"

23The whole company of them rose up and brought him before Pilate. ²They began to accuse him, saying, "We found this man perverting the nation, forbidding paying taxes to Caesar, and saying that he himself is Messiah, a king." ³Pilate asked him, "Are you the King of the Jews?" He answered him, "So you say." ⁴Pilate said to the chief priests and the multitudes, "I find no basis for a charge against this man." ⁵But they insisted, saying, "He stirs up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee even to this place." ⁶But when Pilate heard Galilee mentioned, he asked if the man was a Galilean. ⁷When he found out that he was in Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to Herod, who was also in Jerusalem during those days. ⁸Now when Herod saw Yeshua, he was exceedingly glad, for he had wanted to see him for a long time, because he had heard many things about him. He hoped to see some miracle done by him. ⁹He questioned him with many words, but he gave no answers. ¹⁰The chief priests and the scribes stood, vehemently accusing him. ¹¹Herod with his soldiers humiliated him and mocked him. Dressing him in luxurious clothing, they sent him back to Pilate. ¹²Herod and Pilate became friends with each other that very day, for before that they were enemies with each other. ¹³Pilate called together the chief priests, the rulers, and the people, ¹⁴and said to them, "You brought this man to me as one that perverts the people, and behold, having examined him before you, I found no basis for a charge against this man concerning those things of which you accuse him. ¹⁵Neither has Herod, for I sent you to him, and see, nothing worthy of death has been done by him. ¹⁶I will therefore chastise him and release him." ¹⁷Now he had to release one prisoner to them at the feast. ^{xlv} ¹⁸But they all cried out together, saying, "Away with this man! Release to us Barabbas!"—¹⁹one who was thrown into prison for a certain revolt in the city, and for murder. ²⁰Then Pilate spoke to them again, wanting to release Yeshua, ²¹but they shouted, saying, "Crucify! Crucify him!" ²²He said to them the third time, "Why? What evil has this man done? I have found no capital crime in him. I will therefore chastise him and release him." ²³But they were urgent with loud voices, asking that he might be crucified. Their voices and the voices of the chief priests prevailed.

^{xlv}NU omits verse 17.

²⁴Pilate decreed that what they asked for should be done. ²⁵He released him who had been thrown into prison for insurrection and murder, for whom they asked, but he delivered Yeshua up to their will. ²⁶When they led him away, they grabbed one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country, and laid the cross on him to carry it after Yeshua. ²⁷A great multitude of the people followed him, including women who also mourned and lamented him. ²⁸But Yeshua, turning to them, said, “Daughters of Jerusalem, don’t weep for me, but weep for yourselves and for your children. ²⁹For behold, the days are coming in which they will say, ‘Blessed are the barren, the wombs that never bore, and the breasts that never nursed.’ ³⁰Then they will begin to tell the mountains, ‘Fall on us!’ and tell the hills, ‘Cover us.’ ³¹For if they do these things in the green tree, what will be done in the dry?” ³²There were also others, two criminals, led with him to be put to death. ³³When they came to the place that is called “The Skull”, they crucified him there with the criminals, one on the right and the other on the left. ³⁴Yeshua said, “Father, forgive them, for they don’t know what they are doing.” Dividing his garments among them, they cast lots. ³⁵The people stood watching. The rulers with them also scoffed at him, saying, “He saved others. Let him save himself, if this is the Messiah of God, his chosen one!” ³⁶The soldiers also mocked him, coming to him and offering him vinegar, ³⁷and saying, “If you are the King of the Jews, save yourself!” ³⁸An inscription was also written over him in letters of Greek, Latin, and Hebrew: “THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.” ³⁹One of the criminals who was hanged insulted him, saying, “If you are the Messiah, save yourself and us!” ⁴⁰But the other answered, and rebuking him said, “Don’t you even fear God, seeing you are under the same condemnation? ⁴¹And we indeed justly, for we receive the due reward for our deeds, but this man has done nothing wrong.” ⁴²He said to Yeshua, “Lord, remember me when you come into your Kingdom.” ⁴³Yeshua said to him, “Assuredly I tell you, today you will be with me in Paradise.” ⁴⁴It was now about the sixth hour, ^{xlvi} and darkness came over the whole land until the ninth hour. ^{xlvi} ⁴⁵The sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was torn in two. ⁴⁶Yeshua, crying with a loud voice, said, “Father, into your hands I commit my spirit!” Having said this, he breathed his last. ⁴⁷When the centurion saw what was done, he glorified God, saying, “Certainly this was a righteous man.” ⁴⁸All the multitudes that came together to see this, when they saw the things that were done, returned home beating their breasts. ⁴⁹All his acquaintances and the women who followed with him from Galilee stood at a distance, watching these things. ⁵⁰Behold, there was a man named Joseph, who was a member of the council, a

good and righteous man ⁵¹(he had not consented to their counsel and deed), from Arimathea, a city of the Judeans, who was also waiting for God’s Kingdom. ⁵²This man went to Pilate, and asked for Yeshua’s body. ⁵³He took it down and wrapped it in a linen cloth, and laid him in a tomb that was cut in stone, where no one had ever been laid. ⁵⁴It was the day of the Preparation, and the Sabbath was drawing near. ⁵⁵The women who had come with him out of Galilee followed after, and saw the tomb and how his body was laid. ⁵⁶They returned and prepared spices and ointments. On the Sabbath they rested according to the commandment.

24 But on the first day of the week, at early dawn, they and some others came to the tomb, bringing the spices which they had prepared. ²They found the stone rolled away from the tomb. ³They entered in, and didn’t find the Lord Yeshua’s body. ⁴While they were greatly perplexed about this, behold, two men stood by them in dazzling clothing. ⁵Becoming terrified, they bowed their faces down to the earth. The men said to them, “Why do you seek the living among the dead? ⁶He isn’t here, but is risen. Remember what he told you when he was still in Galilee, ⁷saying that the Son of Man must be delivered up into the hands of sinful men and be crucified, and the third day rise again?” ⁸They remembered his words, ⁹returned from the tomb, and told all these things to the Eleven and to all the rest. ¹⁰Now they were Miriam Magdalene, Yochanah, and Miriam the mother of Jacob. The other women with them told these things to the emissaries. ¹¹These words seemed to them to be nonsense, and they didn’t believe them. ¹²But Peter got up and ran to the tomb. Stooping and looking in, he saw the strips of linen lying by themselves, and he departed to his home, wondering what had happened. ¹³Behold, two of them were going that very day to a village named Emmaus, which was sixty stadia ^{xlvi} from Jerusalem. ¹⁴They talked with each other about all of these things which had happened. ¹⁵While they talked and questioned together, Yeshua himself came near, and went with them. ¹⁶But their eyes were kept from recognizing him. ¹⁷He said to them, “What are you talking about as you walk, and are sad?” ¹⁸One of them, named Klofah, answered him, “Are you the only stranger in Jerusalem who doesn’t know the things which have happened there in these days?” ¹⁹He said to them, “What things?” They said to him, “The things concerning Yeshua the Nazarene, who was a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people; ²⁰and how the chief priests and our rulers delivered him up to be condemned to death, and crucified him. ²¹But we were hoping that it was he who would redeem Israel. Yes, and besides all this, it is now the third day since these things happened. ²²Also, certain women of our company amazed us, having arrived early

^{xlvi}Time was counted from sunrise, so the sixth hour was about noon.

^{xlvi}3:00 p.m.

^{xlvi}60 stadia = about 11 kilometers or about 7 miles.

at the tomb; ²³and when they didn't find his body, they came saying that they had also seen a vision of angels, who said that he was alive. ²⁴Some of us went to the tomb and found it just like the women had said, but they didn't see him." ²⁵He said to them, " Foolish people, and slow of heart to believe in all that the prophets have spoken! ²⁶Didn't the Messiah have to suffer these things and to enter into his glory?" ²⁷Beginning from Moses and from all the prophets, he explained to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself. ²⁸They came near to the village where they were going, and he acted like he would go further. ²⁹They urged him, saying, "Stay with us, for it is almost evening, and the day is almost over." He went in to stay with them. ³⁰When he had sat down at the table with them, he took the bread and gave thanks. Breaking it, he gave it to them. ³¹Their eyes were opened and they recognized him; then he vanished out of their sight. ³²They said to one another, "Weren't our hearts burning within us while he spoke to us along the way, and while he opened the Scriptures to us?" ³³They rose up that very hour, returned to Jerusalem, and found the eleven gathered together, and those who were with them, ³⁴saying, "The Lord is risen indeed, and has appeared to Simon!" ³⁵They related the things that happened along the way, and how he was recognized by them in the breaking of the bread. ³⁶As they said these things, Yeshua himself stood among them, and said to them, "Peace be to you." ³⁷But they were terrified and filled with fear, and supposed that they had seen a spirit. ³⁸He said to them, " Why are you troubled? Why do doubts arise in your hearts? ³⁹See my hands and my feet, that it is truly me. Touch me and see, for a spirit doesn't have flesh and bones, as you see that I have." ⁴⁰When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his feet. ⁴¹While they still didn't believe for joy, and wondered, he said to them, " Do you have anything here to eat?" ⁴²They gave him a piece of a broiled fish and some honeycomb. ⁴³He took them, and ate in front of them. ⁴⁴He said to them, " This is what I told you while I was still with you, that all things which are written in the Torah of Moses, the Prophets, and the Psalms concerning me must be fulfilled." ⁴⁵Then he opened their minds, that they might understand the Scriptures. ⁴⁶He said to them, " Thus it is written, and thus it was necessary for the Messiah to suffer and to rise from the dead the third day, ⁴⁷and that repentance and remission of sins should be preached in his name to all the nations, beginning at Jerusalem. ⁴⁸You are witnesses of these things. ⁴⁹Behold, I send out the promise of my Father on you. But wait in the city of Jerusalem until you are clothed with power from on high." ⁵⁰He led them out as far as Bethany, and he lifted up his hands and blessed them. ⁵¹While he blessed them, he withdrew from them and was carried up into heaven. ⁵²They worshiped him and returned to Jerusalem with great joy, ⁵³and were continually in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

Yochanan

¹In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ²The same was in the beginning with God. ³All things were made through him. Without him, nothing was made that has been made. ⁴In him was life, and the life was the light of men. ⁵The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness hasn't overcome ⁱ it. ⁶There came a man sent from God, whose name was Yochanan. ⁷The same came as a witness, that he might testify about the light, that all might believe through him. ⁸He was not the light, but was sent that he might testify about the light. ⁹The true light that enlightens everyone was coming into the world. ¹⁰He was in the world, and the world was made through him, and the world didn't recognize him. ¹¹He came to his own, and those who were his own didn't receive him. ¹²But as many as received him, to them he gave the right to become God's children, to those who believe in his name: ¹³who were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God. ¹⁴The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the only born ⁱⁱ Son of the Father, full of grace and truth. ¹⁵Yochanan testified about him. He cried out, saying, "This was he of whom I said, 'He who comes after me has surpassed me, for he was before me.'" ¹⁶From his fullness we all received grace upon grace. ¹⁷For the Torah was given through Moses. Grace and truth were realized through Yeshua the Messiah. ⁱⁱⁱ ¹⁸No one has seen God at any time. The only born ^{iv} Son, ^v who is in the bosom of the Father, has declared him. ¹⁹This is Yochanan's testimony, when the Judeans sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, "Who are you?" ²⁰He declared, and didn't deny, but he declared, "I am not the Messiah." ²¹They asked him, "What then? Are you Elijah?" He said, "I am not." "Are you the prophet?" He answered, "No." ²²They said therefore to him, "Who are you? Give us an answer to take back to those who sent

us. What do you say about yourself?" ²³He said, "I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, 'Make straight the way of the Lord,' as Isaiah the prophet said." ²⁴The ones who had been sent were from the Pharisees. ²⁵They asked him, "Why then do you immerse if you are not the Messiah, nor Elijah, nor the prophet?" ²⁶Yochanan answered them, "I immerse in water, but among you stands one whom you don't know. ²⁷He is the one who comes after me, who is preferred before me, whose sandal strap I'm not worthy to loosen." ²⁸These things were done in Bethany beyond the Jordan, where Yochanan was immersing. ²⁹The next day, he saw Yeshua coming to him, and said, "Behold, ^{vi} the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" ³⁰This is he of whom I said, 'After me comes a man who is preferred before me, for he was before me.' ³¹I didn't know him, but for this reason I came immersing in water, that he would be revealed to Israel." ³²Yochanan testified, saying, "I have seen the Spirit descending like a dove out of heaven, and it remained on him. ³³I didn't recognize him, but he who sent me to immerse in water said to me, 'On whomever you will see the Spirit descending and remaining on him is he who immerses in the Holy Spirit.' ³⁴I have seen and have testified that this is the Son of God." ³⁵Again, the next day, Yochanan was standing with two of his disciples, ³⁶and he looked at Yeshua as he walked, and said, "Behold, the Lamb of God!" ³⁷The two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Yeshua. ³⁸Yeshua turned and saw them following, and said to them, "What are you looking for?" They said to him, "Rabbi" (which is to say, being interpreted, Teacher), "where are you staying?" ³⁹He said to them, "Come and see." They came and saw where he was staying, and they stayed with him that day. It was about the tenth hour. ^{vii} ⁴⁰One of the two who heard Yochanan and followed him was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother. ⁴¹He first found his own brother, Simon, and said to him, "We have found the Messiah!" (which is, being interpreted, Anointed One ^{viii}). ⁴²He brought him to Yeshua. Yeshua looked at him and said, " (You are

ⁱThe word translated "overcome" () can also be translated "comprehended." It refers to getting a grip on an enemy to defeat him.

ⁱⁱThe phrase "only born" is from the Greek word " ", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

ⁱⁱⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

^{iv}The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word " ", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

^vNU reads "God"

^{vi}"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{vii}4:00 p.m.

^{viii}"Messiah" (Hebrew) and "Christ" (Greek) both mean "Anointed One".

Simon the son of Jonah. You shall be called Kefa” which is by interpretation, Peter).^{ix} ⁴³On the next day, he was determined to go out into Galilee, and he found Philip. Yeshua said to him, “Follow me.” ⁴⁴Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter. ⁴⁵Philip found Nathanael, and said to him, “We have found him of whom Moses in the Torah and also the prophets, wrote: Yeshua of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.” ⁴⁶Nathanael said to him, “Can any good thing come out of Nazareth?” Philip said to him, “Come and see.” ⁴⁷Yeshua saw Nathanael coming to him, and said about him, “Behold, an Israelite indeed, in whom is no deceit!” ⁴⁸Nathanael said to him, “How do you know me?” Yeshua answered him, “Before Philip called you, when you were under the fig tree, I saw you.” ⁴⁹Nathanael answered him, “Rabbi, you are the Son of God! You are King of Israel!” ⁵⁰Yeshua answered him, “Because I told you, ‘I saw you underneath the fig tree,’ do you believe? You will see greater things than these!” ⁵¹He said to him, “Most certainly, I tell you all, hereafter you will see heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.”

²The third day, there was a wedding in Cana of Galilee. Yeshua’s mother was there. ²Yeshua also was invited, with his disciples, to the wedding. ³When the wine ran out, Yeshua’s mother said to him, “They have no wine.” ⁴Yeshua said to her, “Woman, what does that have to do with you and me? My hour has not yet come.” ⁵His mother said to the servants, “Whatever he says to you, do it.” ⁶Now there were six water pots of stone set there after the Jews’ way of purifying, containing two or three metretes^x apiece. ⁷Yeshua said to them, “Fill the water pots with water.” So they filled them up to the brim. ⁸He said to them, “Now draw some out, and take it to the ruler of the feast.” So they took it. ⁹When the ruler of the feast tasted the water now become wine, and didn’t know where it came from (but the servants who had drawn the water knew), the ruler of the feast called the bridegroom ¹⁰and said to him, “Everyone serves the good wine first, and when the guests have drunk freely, then that which is worse. You have kept the good wine until now!” ¹¹This beginning of his signs Yeshua did in Cana of Galilee, and revealed his glory; and his disciples believed in him. ¹²After this, he went down to Capernaum, he, and his mother, his brothers, and his disciples; and they stayed there a few days. ¹³The Passover in Judea was at hand, and Yeshua went up to Jerusalem. ¹⁴He found in the temple those who sold oxen, sheep, and doves, and the changers of money sitting. ¹⁵He made a whip of cords and drove all out of the temple, both the sheep and the oxen; and he poured out the changers’ money and overthrew their tables. ¹⁶To those who sold the doves, he said,

“Take these things out of here! Don’t make my Father’s house a marketplace!” ¹⁷His disciples remembered that it was written, “Zeal for your house will eat me up.” ¹⁸The Judeans therefore answered him, “What sign do you show us, seeing that you do these things?” ¹⁹Yeshua answered them, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.” ²⁰The Judeans therefore said, “It took forty-six years to build this temple! Will you raise it up in three days?” ²¹But he spoke of the temple of his body. ²²When therefore he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered that he said this, and they believed the Scripture and the word which Yeshua had said. ²³Now when he was in Jerusalem at the Passover, during the feast, many believed in his name, observing his signs which he did. ²⁴But Yeshua didn’t entrust himself to them, because he knew everyone, ²⁵and because he didn’t need for anyone to testify concerning man; for he himself knew what was in man.

³Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Judeans. ²He came to Yeshua by night and said to him, “Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher come from God, for no one can do these signs that you do, unless God is with him.” ³Yeshua answered him, “Most certainly I tell you, unless one is born anew,^{xi} he can’t see God’s Kingdom.” ⁴Nicodemus said to him, “How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother’s womb and be born?” ⁵Yeshua answered, “Most certainly I tell you, unless one is born of water and Spirit, he can’t enter into God’s Kingdom. ⁶That which is born of the flesh is flesh. That which is born of the Spirit is spirit. ⁷Don’t marvel that I said to you, ‘You must be born anew.’ ⁸The wind^{xii} blows where it wants to, and you hear its sound, but don’t know where it comes from and where it is going. So is everyone who is born of the Spirit.” ⁹Nicodemus answered him, “How can these things be?” ¹⁰Yeshua answered him, “Are you the teacher of Israel, and don’t understand these things? ¹¹Most certainly I tell you, we speak that which we know and testify of that which we have seen, and you don’t receive our witness. ¹²If I told you earthly things and you don’t believe, how will you believe if I tell you heavenly things? ¹³No one has ascended into heaven but he who descended out of heaven, the Son of Man, who is in heaven. ¹⁴As Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up, ¹⁵that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life. ¹⁶For God so loved the world, that he gave his only born^{xiii} Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life. ¹⁷For God didn’t send his Son into the world to judge the world, but that the world should be saved through him.

^{ix}“Kefa” (Aramaic) and “Peter” (Greek) both mean “Rock”.

^x2 to 3 metretes is about 20 to 30 U. S. Gallons, or 75 to 115 liters.

^{xi}The word translated “anew” here and in

^{xii}The same Greek word () means wind, breath, and spirit.

^{xiii}The phrase “only born” is from the Greek word “”, which is sometimes translated “only begotten” or “one and only”.

¹⁸He who believes in him is not judged. He who doesn't believe has been judged already, because he has not believed in the name of the only born Son of God. ¹⁹This is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and men loved the darkness rather than the light, for their works were evil. ²⁰For everyone who does evil hates the light and doesn't come to the light, lest his works would be exposed. ²¹But he who does the truth comes to the light, that his works may be revealed, that they have been done in God." ²²After these things, Yeshua came with his disciples into the land of Judea. He stayed there with them and immersed. ²³Yochanan also was immersing in Enon near Salim, because there was much water there. They came and were immersed; ²⁴for Yochanan was not yet thrown into prison. ²⁵Therefore a dispute arose on the part of Yochanan's disciples with some Judeans about purification. ²⁶They came to Yochanan and said to him, "Rabbi, he who was with you beyond the Jordan, to whom you have testified, behold, he immerses, and everyone is coming to him." ²⁷Yochanan answered, "A man can receive nothing unless it has been given him from heaven. ²⁸You yourselves testify that I said, 'I am not the Messiah,' but, 'I have been sent before him.' ²⁹He who has the bride is the bridegroom; but the friend of the bridegroom, who stands and hears him, rejoices greatly because of the bridegroom's voice. Therefore my joy is made full. ³⁰He must increase, but I must decrease. ³¹"He who comes from above is above all. He who is from the earth belongs to the earth and speaks of the earth. He who comes from heaven is above all. ³²What he has seen and heard, of that he testifies; and no one receives his witness. ³³He who has received his witness has set his seal to this, that God is true. ³⁴For he whom God has sent speaks the words of God; for God gives the Spirit without measure. ³⁵The Father loves the Son, and has given all things into his hand. ³⁶One who believes in the Son has eternal life, but one who disobeys ^{xiv} the Son won't see life, but the wrath of God remains on him."

⁴Therefore when the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Yeshua was making and immersing more disciples than Yochanan ²(although Yeshua himself didn't immerse, but his disciples), ³he left Judea and departed into Galilee. ⁴He needed to pass through Samaria. ⁵So he came to a city of Samaria called Sychar, near the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph. ⁶Jacob's well was there. Yeshua therefore, being tired from his journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour. ^{xv} ⁷A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Yeshua said to her, "Give me a drink." ⁸For his disciples had gone away into the city to buy food. ⁹The Samaritan woman there-

fore said to him, "How is it that you, being a Jew, ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?" (For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans.) ¹⁰Yeshua answered her, "If you knew the gift of God, and who it is who says to you, 'Give me a drink,' you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water." ¹¹The woman said to him, "Sir, you have nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. So where do you get that living water?" ¹²Are you greater than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank from it himself, as did his children and his livestock?" ¹³Yeshua answered her, "Everyone who drinks of this water will thirst again, ¹⁴but whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never thirst again; but the water that I will give him will become in him a well of water springing up to eternal life." ¹⁵The woman said to him, "Sir, give me this water, so that I don't get thirsty, neither come all the way here to draw." ¹⁶Yeshua said to her, "Go, call your husband, and come here." ¹⁷The woman answered, "I have no husband." Yeshua said to her, "You said well, 'I have no husband,' ¹⁸for you have had five husbands; and he whom you now have is not your husband. This you have said truly." ¹⁹The woman said to him, "Sir, I perceive that you are a prophet. ²⁰Our fathers worshiped in this mountain, and you Jews say that in Jerusalem is the place where people ought to worship." ²¹Yeshua said to her, "Woman, believe me, the hour is coming when neither in this mountain nor in Jerusalem will you worship the Father. ²²You worship that which you don't know. We worship that which we know; for salvation is from the Jews. ²³But the hour comes, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such to be his worshipers. ²⁴God is spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and truth." ²⁵The woman said to him, "I know that Messiah is coming, he who is called Messiah. ^{xvi} When he has come, he will declare to us all things." ²⁶Yeshua said to her, "I am he, the one who speaks to you." ²⁷Just then, his disciples came. They marveled that he was speaking with a woman; yet no one said, "What are you looking for?" or, "Why do you speak with her?" ²⁸So the woman left her water pot, went away into the city, and said to the people, ²⁹"Come, see a man who told me everything that I have done. Can this be the Messiah?" ³⁰They went out of the city, and were coming to him. ³¹In the meanwhile, the disciples urged him, saying, "Rabbi, eat." ³²But he said to them, "I have food to eat that you don't know about." ³³The disciples therefore said to one another, "Has anyone brought him something to eat?" ³⁴Yeshua said to them, "My food is to do the will of him who sent me and to accomplish his work. ³⁵Don't you say, 'There are yet four months until the harvest?' Behold, I tell you, lift up your eyes and look at the fields, that they are white for har-

^{xiv}The same word can be translated "disobeys" or "disbelieves" in this context.

^{xv}noon

^{xvi}"Messiah" (Hebrew) and "Christ" (Greek) both mean "Anointed One".

vest already. ³⁶He who reaps receives wages and gathers fruit to eternal life, that both he who sows and he who reaps may rejoice together. ³⁷For in this the saying is true, 'One sows, and another reaps.' ³⁸I sent you to reap that for which you haven't labored. Others have labored, and you have entered into their labor." ³⁹From that city many of the Samaritans believed in him because of the word of the woman, who testified, "He told me everything that I have done." ⁴⁰So when the Samaritans came to him, they begged him to stay with them. He stayed there two days. ⁴¹Many more believed because of his word. ⁴²They said to the woman, "Now we believe, not because of your speaking; for we have heard for ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Messiah, the Savior of the world." ⁴³After the two days he went out from there and went into Galilee. ⁴⁴For Yeshua himself testified that a prophet has no honor in his own country. ⁴⁵So when he came into Galilee, the Galileans received him, having seen all the things that he did in Jerusalem at the feast, for they also went to the feast. ⁴⁶Yeshua came therefore again to Cana of Galilee, where he made the water into wine. There was a certain nobleman whose son was sick at Capernaum. ⁴⁷When he heard that Yeshua had come out of Judea into Galilee, he went to him and begged him that he would come down and heal his son, for he was at the point of death. ⁴⁸Yeshua therefore said to him, "Unless you see signs and wonders, you will in no way believe." ⁴⁹The nobleman said to him, "Sir, come down before my child dies." ⁵⁰Yeshua said to him, "Go your way. Your son lives." The man believed the word that Yeshua spoke to him, and he went his way. ⁵¹As he was going down, his servants met him and reported, saying "Your child lives!" ⁵²So he inquired of them the hour when he began to get better. They said therefore to him, "Yesterday at the seventh hour, ^{xvii} the fever left him." ⁵³So the father knew that it was at that hour in which Yeshua said to him, "Your son lives." He believed, as did his whole house. ⁵⁴This is again the second sign that Yeshua did, having come out of Judea into Galilee.

⁵After these things, there was a Jewish festival, and Yeshua went up to Jerusalem. ²Now in Jerusalem by the sheep gate, there is a pool, which is called in Hebrew, "Bethesda", having five porches. ³In these lay a great multitude of those who were sick, blind, lame, or paralyzed, waiting for the moving of the water; ⁴for an angel went down at certain times into the pool and stirred up the water. Whoever stepped in first after the stirring of the water was healed of whatever disease he had. ^{xviii} ⁵A certain man was there who had been sick for thirty-eight years. ⁶When Yeshua saw him lying there, and knew that he had been sick for a long time, he asked him, "Do you want to be made well?" ⁷The sick man answered him,

"Sir, I have no one to put me into the pool when the water is stirred up, but while I'm coming, another steps down before me." ⁸Yeshua said to him, "Arise, take up your mat, and walk." ⁹Immediately, the man was made well, and took up his mat and walked. Now that day was a Sabbath. ¹⁰So the Judeans said to him who was cured, "It is the Sabbath. It is not lawful for you to carry the mat." ¹¹He answered them, "He who made me well said to me, 'Take up your mat and walk.'" ¹²Then they asked him, "Who is the man who said to you, 'Take up your mat and walk'?" ¹³But he who was healed didn't know who it was, for Yeshua had withdrawn, a crowd being in the place. ¹⁴Afterward Yeshua found him in the temple and said to him, "Behold, you are made well. Sin no more, so that nothing worse happens to you." ¹⁵The man went away, and told the Judeans that it was Yeshua who had made him well. ¹⁶For this cause the Judeans persecuted Yeshua and sought to kill him, because he did these things on the Sabbath. ¹⁷But Yeshua answered them, "My Father is still working, so I am working, too." ¹⁸For this cause therefore the Judeans sought all the more to kill him, because he not only broke the Sabbath, but also called God his own Father, making himself equal with God. ¹⁹Yeshua therefore answered them, "Most certainly, I tell you, the Son can do nothing of himself, but what he sees the Father doing. For whatever things he does, these the Son also does likewise. ²⁰For the Father has affection for the Son, and shows him all things that he himself does. He will show him greater works than these, that you may marvel. ²¹For as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son also gives life to whom he desires. ²²For the Father judges no one, but he has given all judgment to the Son, ²³that all may honor the Son, even as they honor the Father. He who doesn't honor the Son doesn't honor the Father who sent him. ²⁴"Most certainly I tell you, he who hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life, and doesn't come into judgment, but has passed out of death into life. ²⁵Most certainly I tell you, the hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the Son of God's voice; and those who hear will live. ²⁶For as the Father has life in himself, even so he gave to the Son also to have life in himself. ²⁷He also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is a son of man. ²⁸Don't marvel at this, for the hour comes in which all who are in the tombs will hear his voice ²⁹and will come out; those who have done good, to the resurrection of life; and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment. ³⁰I can of myself do nothing. As I hear, I judge; and my judgment is righteous, because I don't seek my own will, but the will of my Father who sent me. ³¹"If I testify about myself, my witness is not valid. ³²It is another who testifies about me. I know that the testimony which he testifies about me is true. ³³You have sent to Yochanan, and he has testified to the truth. ³⁴But the testimony which I receive is not

^{xvii}1:00 p.m.

^{xviii}NU omits from "waiting" in verse 3 to the end of verse 4.

from man. However, I say these things that you may be saved. ³⁵He was the burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a while in his light. ³⁶But the testimony which I have is greater than that of Yochanan; for the works which the Father gave me to accomplish, the very works that I do, testify about me, that the Father has sent me. ³⁷The Father himself, who sent me, has testified about me. You have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his form. ³⁸You don't have his word living in you, because you don't believe him whom he sent. ³⁹" You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me. ⁴⁰Yet you will not come to me, that you may have life. ⁴¹I don't receive glory from men. ⁴²But I know you, that you don't have God's love in yourselves. ⁴³I have come in my Father's name, and you don't receive me. If another comes in his own name, you will receive him. ⁴⁴How can you believe, who receive glory from one another, and you don't seek the glory that comes from the only God? ⁴⁵" Don't think that I will accuse you to the Father. There is one who accuses you, even Moses, on whom you have set your hope. ⁴⁶For if you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me. ⁴⁷But if you don't believe his writings, how will you believe my words?"

6After these things, Yeshua went away to the other side of the sea of Galilee, which is also called the Sea of Tiberias. ²A great multitude followed him, because they saw his signs which he did on those who were sick. ³Yeshua went up into the mountain, and he sat there with his disciples. ⁴Now the Passover, the Jewish festival, was at hand. ⁵Yeshua therefore, lifting up his eyes and seeing that a great multitude was coming to him, said to Philip, "Where are we to buy bread, that these may eat?" ⁶He said this to test him, for he himself knew what he would do. ⁷Philip answered him, "Two hundred denarii ^{xix} worth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may receive a little." ⁸One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, said to him, ⁹"There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish, but what are these among so many?" ¹⁰Yeshua said, "Have the people sit down." Now there was much grass in that place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand. ¹¹Yeshua took the loaves, and having given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those who were sitting down, likewise also of the fish as much as they desired. ¹²When they were filled, he said to his disciples, "Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost." ¹³So they gathered them up, and filled twelve baskets with broken pieces from the five barley loaves, which were left over by those who had eaten. ¹⁴When therefore the people saw

the sign which Yeshua did, they said, "This is truly the Prophet who comes into the world." ¹⁵Yeshua therefore, perceiving that they were about to come and take him by force to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself. ¹⁶When evening came, his disciples went down to the sea. ¹⁷They entered into the boat, and were going over the sea to Capernaum. It was now dark, and Yeshua had not come to them. ¹⁸The sea was tossed by a great wind blowing. ¹⁹When therefore they had rowed about twenty-five or thirty stadia, ^{xx} they saw Yeshua walking on the sea and drawing near to the boat; and they were afraid. ²⁰But he said to them, "It is I. ^{xxi} Don't be afraid." ²¹They were willing therefore to receive him into the boat. Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going. ²²On the next day, the multitude that stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was no other boat there, except the one in which his disciples had embarked, and that Yeshua hadn't entered with his disciples into the boat, but his disciples had gone away alone. ²³However, boats from Tiberias came near to the place where they ate the bread after the Lord had given thanks. ²⁴When the multitude therefore saw that Yeshua wasn't there, nor his disciples, they themselves got into the boats and came to Capernaum, seeking Yeshua. ²⁵When they found him on the other side of the sea, they asked him, "Rabbi, when did you come here?" ²⁶Yeshua answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, you seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves and were filled. ²⁷Don't work for the food which perishes, but for the food which remains to eternal life, which the Son of Man will give to you. For God the Father has sealed him." ²⁸They said therefore to him, "What must we do, that we may work the works of God?" ²⁹Yeshua answered them, "This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he has sent." ³⁰They said therefore to him, "What then do you do for a sign, that we may see and believe you? What work do you do?" ³¹Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness. As it is written, 'He gave them bread out of heaven ^{xxii} to eat.'" ³²Yeshua therefore said to them, "Most certainly, I tell you, it wasn't Moses who gave you the bread out of heaven, but my Father gives you the true bread out of heaven. ³³For the bread of God is that which comes down out of heaven and gives life to the world." ³⁴They said therefore to him, "Lord, always give us this bread." ³⁵Yeshua said to them, "I am the bread of life. Whoever comes to me will not be hungry, and whoever believes in me will never be thirsty. ³⁶But I told you that you have seen me, and yet you don't believe. ³⁷All those whom the Father gives me will come to me. He who comes to me I will in no way throw out. ³⁸For I have come down from heaven, not to do my own

^{xix}A denarius was a silver coin worth about a day's wages for an agricultural laborer, so 200 denarii would be between 6 and 7 month's pay.

^{xx}25 to 30 stadia is about 5 to 6 kilometers or about 3 to 4 miles
^{xxi}or, I AM

^{xxii}Greek and Hebrew use the same word for "heaven", "the heavens", "the sky", and "the air".

will, but the will of him who sent me. ³⁹This is the will of my Father who sent me, that of all he has given to me I should lose nothing, but should raise him up at the last day. ⁴⁰This is the will of the one who sent me, that everyone who sees the Son and believes in him should have eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day.” ⁴¹The Judeans therefore murmured concerning him, because he said, “I am the bread which came down out of heaven.” ⁴²They said, “Isn’t this Yeshua, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How then does he say, ‘I have come down out of heaven?’” ⁴³Therefore Yeshua answered them, “Don’t murmur among yourselves. ⁴⁴No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him; and I will raise him up in the last day. ⁴⁵It is written in the Prophets, ‘They will all be taught by God.’ Therefore everyone who hears from the Father and has learned, comes to me. ⁴⁶Not that anyone has seen the Father, except he who is from God. He has seen the Father. ⁴⁷Most certainly, I tell you, he who believes in me has eternal life. ⁴⁸I am the bread of life. ⁴⁹Your fathers ate the manna in the wilderness and they died. ⁵⁰This is the bread which comes down out of heaven, that anyone may eat of it and not die. ⁵¹I am the living bread which came down out of heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever. Yes, the bread which I will give for the life of the world is my flesh.” ⁵²The Judeans therefore contended with one another, saying, “How can this man give us his flesh to eat?” ⁵³Yeshua therefore said to them, “Most certainly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you don’t have life in yourselves. ⁵⁴He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise him up at the last day. ⁵⁵For my flesh is food indeed, and my blood is drink indeed. ⁵⁶He who eats my flesh and drinks my blood lives in me, and I in him. ⁵⁷As the living Father sent me, and I live because of the Father, so he who feeds on me will also live because of me. ⁵⁸This is the bread which came down out of heaven—not as our fathers ate the manna and died. He who eats this bread will live forever.” ⁵⁹He said these things in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum. ⁶⁰Therefore many of his disciples, when they heard this, said, “This is a hard saying! Who can listen to it?” ⁶¹But Yeshua knowing in himself that his disciples murmured at this, said to them, “Does this cause you to stumble? ⁶²Then what if you would see the Son of Man ascending to where he was before? ⁶³It is the spirit who gives life. The flesh profits nothing. The words that I speak to you are spirit, and are life. ⁶⁴But there are some of you who don’t believe.” For Yeshua knew from the beginning who they were who didn’t believe, and who it was who would betray him. ⁶⁵He said, “For this cause I have said to you that no one can come to me, unless it is given to him by my Father.” ⁶⁶At this, many of his disciples went back and walked no more with him. ⁶⁷Yeshua said therefore to the twelve, “You don’t also want to go away,

do you?” ⁶⁸Simon Peter answered him, “Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life. ⁶⁹We have come to believe and know that you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” ⁷⁰Yeshua answered them, “Didn’t I choose you, the twelve, and one of you is a devil?” ⁷¹Now he spoke of Judah, the son of Simon Iscariot, for it was he who would betray him, being one of the twelve.

7 After these things, Yeshua was walking in Galilee, for he wouldn’t walk in Judea, because the Judeans sought to kill him. ²Now the Jewish festival, the Feast of Sukkot, was at hand. ³His brothers therefore said to him, “Depart from here and go into Judea, that your disciples also may see your works which you do. ⁴For no one does anything in secret while he seeks to be known openly. If you do these things, reveal yourself to the world.” ⁵For even his brothers didn’t believe in him. ⁶Yeshua therefore said to them, “My time has not yet come, but your time is always ready. ⁷The world can’t hate you, but it hates me, because I testify about it, that its works are evil. ⁸You go up to the feast. I am not yet going up to this feast, because my time is not yet fulfilled.” ⁹Having said these things to them, he stayed in Galilee. ¹⁰But when his brothers had gone up to the feast, then he also went up, not publicly, but as it were in secret. ¹¹The Judeans therefore sought him at the feast, and said, “Where is he?” ¹²There was much murmuring among the multitudes concerning him. Some said, “He is a good man.” Others said, “Not so, but he leads the multitude astray.” ¹³Yet no one spoke openly of him for fear of the Judeans. ¹⁴But when it was now the middle of the feast, Yeshua went up into the temple and taught. ¹⁵The Judeans therefore marveled, saying, “How does this man know letters, having never been educated?” ¹⁶Yeshua therefore answered them, “My teaching is not mine, but his who sent me. ¹⁷If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching, whether it is from God or if I am speaking from myself. ¹⁸He who speaks from himself seeks his own glory, but he who seeks the glory of him who sent him is true, and no unrighteousness is in him. ¹⁹Didn’t Moses give you the Torah, and yet none of you keeps the Torah? Why do you seek to kill me?” ²⁰The multitude answered, “You have a demon! Who seeks to kill you?” ²¹Yeshua answered them, “I did one work and you all marvel because of it. ²²Moses has given you circumcision (not that it is of Moses, but of the fathers), and on the Sabbath you circumcise a boy. ²³If a boy receives circumcision on the Sabbath, that the Torah of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me because I made a man completely healthy on the Sabbath? ²⁴Don’t judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment.” ²⁵Therefore some of them of Jerusalem said, “Isn’t this he whom they seek to kill? ²⁶Behold, he speaks openly, and they say nothing to him. Can it be that the rulers indeed know that this is truly the Messiah? ²⁷However, we know

where this man comes from, but when the Messiah comes, no one will know where he comes from.” ²⁸Yeshua therefore cried out in the temple, teaching and saying, “ You both know me, and know where I am from. I have not come of myself, but he who sent me is true, whom you don’t know. ²⁹I know him, because I am from him, and he sent me.” ³⁰They sought therefore to take him; but no one laid a hand on him, because his hour had not yet come. ³¹But of the multitude, many believed in him. They said, “When the Messiah comes, he won’t do more signs than those which this man has done, will he?” ³²The Pharisees heard the multitude murmuring these things concerning him, and the chief priests and the Pharisees sent officers to arrest him. ³³Then Yeshua said, “ I will be with you a little while longer, then I go to him who sent me. ³⁴You will seek me and won’t find me. You can’t come where I am.” ³⁵The Judeans therefore said among themselves, “Where will this man go that we won’t find him? Will he go to the Diaspora among the Greeks and teach the Greeks? ³⁶What is this word that he said, ‘ You will seek me, and won’t find me;’and ‘?’ Where I am, you can’t come’ ³⁷Now on the last and greatest day of the feast ^{xxiii}, Yeshua today as Hoshana Rabbah stood and cried out, “ If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink! ³⁸He who believes in me, as the Scripture has said, from within him will flow rivers of living water.” ³⁹But he said this about the Spirit, which those believing in him were to receive. For the Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Yeshua wasn’t yet glorified. ⁴⁰Many of the multitude therefore, when they heard these words, said, “This is truly the Prophet.” ⁴¹Others said, “This is the Messiah.” But some said, “What, does the Messiah come out of Galilee? ⁴²Hasn’t the Scripture said that the Messiah comes of the offspring ^{xxiv} of David, and from Bethlehem, the village where David was?” ⁴³So a division arose in the multitude because of him. ⁴⁴Some of them would have arrested him, but no one laid hands on him. ⁴⁵The officers therefore came to the chief priests and Pharisees; and they said to them, “Why didn’t you bring him?” ⁴⁶The officers answered, “No man ever spoke like this man!” ⁴⁷The Pharisees therefore answered them, “You aren’t also led astray, are you? ⁴⁸Have any of the rulers or any of the Pharisees believed in him? ⁴⁹But this multitude that doesn’t know the Torah is cursed.” ⁵⁰Nicodemus (he who came to him by night, being one of them) said to them, ⁵¹“Does our Torah judge a man unless it first hears from him personally and knows what he does?” ⁵²They answered him, “Are you also from Galilee? Search and see that no prophet has arisen out of Galilee.” ⁵³Everyone went to his own house,

8but Yeshua went to the Mount of Olives. ²Now very early in the morning, he came again into the temple, and

all the people came to him. He sat down and taught them. ³The scribes and the Pharisees brought a woman taken in adultery. Having set her in the middle, ⁴they told him, “Rabbi, we found this woman in adultery, in the very act. ⁵Now in our Torah, Moses commanded us to stone such women. What then do you say about her?” ⁶They said this testing him, that they might have something to accuse him of. But Yeshua stooped down and wrote on the ground with his finger. ⁷But when they continued asking him, he looked up and said to them, “ He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her.” ⁸Again he stooped down and wrote on the ground with his finger. ⁹They, when they heard it, being convicted by their conscience, went out one by one, beginning from the oldest, even to the last. Yeshua was left alone with the woman where she was, in the middle. ¹⁰Yeshua, standing up, saw her and said, “ Woman, where are your accusers? Did no one condemn you?” ¹¹She said, “No one, Lord.” Yeshua said, “Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more.” ^{xxv} ¹²Again, therefore, Yeshua spoke to them, saying, “I am the light of the world. He who follows me will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life.” ¹³The Pharisees therefore said to him, “You testify about yourself. Your testimony is not valid.” ¹⁴Yeshua answered them, “ Even if I testify about myself, my testimony is true, for I know where I came from, and where I am going; but you don’t know where I came from, or where I am going. ¹⁵You judge according to the flesh. I judge no one. ¹⁶Even if I do judge, my judgment is true, for I am not alone, but I am with the Father who sent me. ¹⁷It’s also written in your Torah that the testimony of two people is valid. ¹⁸I am one who testifies about myself, and the Father who sent me testifies about me.” ¹⁹They said therefore to him, “Where is your Father?” Yeshua answered, “ You know neither me nor my Father. If you knew me, you would know my Father also.” ²⁰Yeshua spoke these words in the treasury, as he taught in the temple. Yet no one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come. ²¹Yeshua said therefore again to them, “ I am going away, and you will seek me, and you will die in your sins. Where I go, you can’t come.” ²²The Judeans therefore said, “Will he kill himself, because he says, ‘?’ Where I am going, you can’t come’ ²³He said to them, “ You are from beneath. I am from above. You are of this world. I am not of this world. ²⁴I said therefore to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am ^{xxvi} he, you will die in your sins.” ²⁵They said therefore to him, “Who are you?” Yeshua said to them, “ Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning. ²⁶I have many things to speak and to judge concerning you. However, he who sent me is true; and the things which I heard from him, these I say to the world.” ²⁷They didn’t understand that he spoke to

^{xxiii}today as Hoshana Rabbah., Yeshua
^{xxiv}or, seed

^{xxv}NU includes
^{xxvi}or, I AM

them about the Father. ²⁸Yeshua therefore said to them, "When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he, and I do nothing of myself, but as my Father taught me, I say these things. ²⁹He who sent me is with me. The Father hasn't left me alone, for I always do the things that are pleasing to him." ³⁰As he spoke these things, many believed in him. ³¹Yeshua therefore said to those Judeans who had believed him, "If you remain in my word, then you are truly my disciples. ³²You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free." ³³They answered him, "We are Abraham's offspring, and have never been in bondage to anyone. How do you say, '?' You will be made free' ³⁴Yeshua answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin. ³⁵A bondservant doesn't live in the house forever. A son remains forever. ³⁶If therefore the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed. ³⁷I know that you are Abraham's offspring, yet you seek to kill me, because my word finds no place in you. ³⁸I say the things which I have seen with my Father; and you also do the things which you have seen with your father." ³⁹They answered him, "Our father is Abraham." Yeshua said to them, "If you were Abraham's children, you would do the works of Abraham. ⁴⁰But now you seek to kill me, a man who has told you the truth which I heard from God. Abraham didn't do this. ⁴¹You do the works of your father." They said to him, "We were not born of sexual immorality. We have one Father, God." ⁴²Therefore Yeshua said to them, "If God were your father, you would love me, for I came out and have come from God. For I haven't come of myself, but he sent me. ⁴³Why don't you understand my speech? Because you can't hear my word. ⁴⁴You are of your father the devil, and you want to do the desires of your father. He was a murderer from the beginning, and doesn't stand in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaks a lie, he speaks on his own; for he is a liar, and the father of lies. ⁴⁵But because I tell the truth, you don't believe me. ⁴⁶Which of you convicts me of sin? If I tell the truth, why do you not believe me? ⁴⁷He who is of God hears the words of God. For this cause you don't hear, because you are not of God." ⁴⁸Then the Judeans answered him, "Don't we say well that you are a Samaritan, and have a demon?" ⁴⁹Yeshua answered, "I don't have a demon, but I honor my Father and you dishonor me. ⁵⁰But I don't seek my own glory. There is one who seeks and judges. ⁵¹Most certainly, I tell you, if a person keeps my word, he will never see death." ⁵²Then the Judeans said to him, "Now we know that you have a demon. Abraham died, as did the prophets; and you say, 'If a man keeps my word, he will never taste of death.' ⁵³Are you greater than our father Abraham, who died? The prophets died. Who do you make yourself out to be?" ⁵⁴Yeshua answered, "If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father who glorifies me, of whom you say that he is our God. ⁵⁵You

have not known him, but I know him. If I said, 'I don't know him,' I would be like you, a liar. But I know him and keep his word. ⁵⁶Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day. He saw it and was glad." ⁵⁷The Judeans therefore said to him, "You are not yet fifty years old! Have you seen Abraham?" ⁵⁸Yeshua said to them, "Most certainly, I tell you, before Abraham came into existence, I AM." ⁵⁹Therefore they took up stones to throw at him, but Yeshua was hid himself and went out of the temple, having gone through the middle of them, and so passed by.

⁹As he passed by, he saw a man blind from birth. ²His disciples asked him, "Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?" ³Yeshua answered, "This man didn't sin, nor did his parents, but that the works of God might be revealed in him. ⁴I must work the works of him who sent me while it is day. The night is coming, when no one can work. ⁵While I am in the world, I am the light of the world." ⁶When he had said this, he spat on the ground, made mud with the saliva, anointed the blind man's eyes with the mud, ⁷and said to him, "(Go, wash in the pool of Siloam" which means "Sent"). So he went away, washed, and came back seeing. ⁸Therefore the neighbors and those who saw that he was blind before said, "Isn't this he who sat and begged?" ⁹Others were saying, "It is he." Still others were saying, "He looks like him." He said, "I am he." ¹⁰They therefore were asking him, "How were your eyes opened?" ¹¹He answered, "A man called Yeshua made mud, anointed my eyes, and said to me, 'Go to the pool of Siloam and wash.' So I went away and washed, and I received sight." ¹²Then they asked him, "Where is he?" He said, "I don't know." ¹³They brought him who had been blind to the Pharisees. ¹⁴It was a Sabbath when Yeshua made the mud and opened his eyes. ¹⁵Again therefore the Pharisees also asked him how he received his sight. He said to them, "He put mud on my eyes, I washed, and I see." ¹⁶Some therefore of the Pharisees said, "This man is not from God, because he doesn't keep the Sabbath." Others said, "How can a man who is a sinner do such signs?" So there was division among them. ¹⁷Therefore they asked the blind man again, "What do you say about him, because he opened your eyes?" He said, "He is a prophet." ¹⁸The Judeans therefore didn't believe concerning him, that he had been blind and had received his sight, until they called the parents of him who had received his sight, ¹⁹and asked them, "Is this your son, whom you say was born blind? How then does he now see?" ²⁰His parents answered them, "We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind; ²¹but how he now sees, we don't know; or who opened his eyes, we don't know. He is of age. Ask him. He will speak for himself." ²²His parents said these things because they feared the Judeans; for the Judeans had already agreed that if any

man would confess him as Messiah, he would be put out of the synagogue. ²³Therefore his parents said, "He is of age. Ask him." ²⁴So they called the man who was blind a second time, and said to him, "Give glory to God. We know that this man is a sinner." ²⁵He therefore answered, "I don't know if he is a sinner. One thing I do know: that though I was blind, now I see." ²⁶They said to him again, "What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?" ²⁷He answered them, "I told you already, and you didn't listen. Why do you want to hear it again? You don't also want to become his disciples, do you?" ²⁸They insulted him and said, "You are his disciple, but we are disciples of Moses. ²⁹We know that God has spoken to Moses. But as for this man, we don't know where he comes from." ³⁰The man answered them, "How amazing! You don't know where he comes from, yet he opened my eyes. ³¹We know that God doesn't listen to sinners, but if anyone is a worshiper of God and does his will, he listens to him. ³²Since the world began it has never been heard of that anyone opened the eyes of someone born blind. ³³If this man were not from God, he could do nothing." ³⁴They answered him, "You were altogether born in sins, and do you teach us?" Then they threw him out. ³⁵Yeshua heard that they had thrown him out, and finding him, he said, "Do you believe in the Son of God?" ³⁶He answered, "Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him?" ³⁷Yeshua said to him, "You have both seen him, and it is he who speaks with you." ³⁸He said, "Lord, I believe!" and he worshiped him. ³⁹Yeshua said, "I came into this world for judgment, that those who don't see may see; and that those who see may become blind." ⁴⁰Those of the Pharisees who were with him heard these things, and said to him, "Are we also blind?" ⁴¹Yeshua said to them, "If you were blind, you would have no sin; but now you say, 'We see.' Therefore your sin remains.

¹⁰"Most certainly, I tell you, one who doesn't enter by the door into the sheep fold, but climbs up some other way, is a thief and a robber. ²But one who enters in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep. ³The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen to his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out. ⁴Whenever he brings out his own sheep, he goes before them; and the sheep follow him, for they know his voice. ⁵They will by no means follow a stranger, but will flee from him; for they don't know the voice of strangers." ⁶Yeshua spoke this parable to them, but they didn't understand what he was telling them. ⁷Yeshua therefore said to them again, "Most certainly, I tell you, I am the sheep's door. ⁸All who came before me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep didn't listen to them. ⁹I am the door. If anyone enters in by me, he will be saved, and will go in and go out and will find pasture. ¹⁰The thief only comes to steal, kill, and destroy. I came that they may have life, and may have it abundantly. ¹¹"I am the good shepherd. The good shep-

herd lays down his life for the sheep. ¹²He who is a hired hand, and not a shepherd, who doesn't own the sheep, sees the wolf coming, leaves the sheep, and flees. The wolf snatches the sheep and scatters them. ¹³The hired hand flees because he is a hired hand and doesn't care for the sheep. ¹⁴I am the good shepherd. I know my own, and I'm known by my own; ¹⁵even as the Father knows me, and I know the Father. I lay down my life for the sheep. ¹⁶I have other sheep which are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will hear my voice. They will become one flock with one shepherd. ¹⁷Therefore the Father loves me, because I lay down my life, that I may take it again. ¹⁸No one takes it away from me, but I lay it down by myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. I received this commandment from my Father." ¹⁹Therefore a division arose again among the Judeans because of these words. ²⁰Many of them said, "He has a demon and is insane! Why do you listen to him?" ²¹Others said, "These are not the sayings of one possessed by a demon. It isn't possible for a demon to open the eyes of the blind, is it?" ²²It was the Feast of Hanukkah ^{xxvii} at Jerusalem. ²³It was winter, and Yeshua was walking in the temple, in Solomon's porch. ²⁴The Judeans therefore came around him and said to him, "How long will you hold us in suspense? If you are the Messiah, tell us plainly." ²⁵Yeshua answered them, "I told you, and you don't believe. The works that I do in my Father's name, these testify about me. ²⁶But you don't believe, because you are not of my sheep, as I told you. ²⁷My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me. ²⁸I give eternal life to them. They will never perish, and no one will snatch them out of my hand. ²⁹My Father who has given them to me is greater than all. No one is able to snatch them out of my Father's hand. ³⁰I and the Father are one." ³¹Therefore the Judeans took up stones again to stone him. ³²Yeshua answered them, "I have shown you many good works from my Father. For which of those works do you stone me?" ³³The Judeans answered him, "We don't stone you for a good work, but for blasphemy, because you, being a man, make yourself God." ³⁴Yeshua answered them, "Isn't it written in your law, 'I said, you are gods?' ³⁵If he called them gods, to whom the word of God came (and the Scripture can't be broken), ³⁶do you say of him whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world, 'You blaspheme,' because I said, 'I am the Son of God?' ³⁷If I don't do the works of my Father, don't believe me. ³⁸But if I do them, though you don't believe me, believe the works, that you may know and believe that the Father is in me, and I in the Father." ³⁹They sought again to seize him, and he went out of their hand. ⁴⁰He went away again beyond the Jordan into the place where Yochanan was immersing at first, and he stayed there. ⁴¹Many came to him. They

^{xxvii}The "Feast of the Dedication" is the Greek name for "Hanukkah", a celebration of the rededication of the Temple.

said, "Yochanan indeed did no sign, but everything that Yochanan said about this man is true." ⁴²Many believed in him there.

¹¹Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus from Bethany, of the village of Miriam and her sister, Martha. ²It was that Miriam who had anointed the Lord with ointment and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus, was sick. ³The sisters therefore sent to him, saying, "Lord, behold, he for whom you have great affection is sick." ⁴But when Yeshua heard it, he said, "This sickness is not to death, but for the glory of God, that God's Son may be glorified by it." ⁵Now Yeshua loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus. ⁶When therefore he heard that he was sick, he stayed two days in the place where he was. ⁷Then after this he said to the disciples, "Let's go into Judea again." ⁸The disciples asked him, "Rabbi, the Judeans were just trying to stone you. Are you going there again?" ⁹Yeshua answered, "Aren't there twelve hours of daylight? If a man walks in the day, he doesn't stumble, because he sees the light of this world. ¹⁰But if a man walks in the night, he stumbles, because the light isn't in him." ¹¹He said these things, and after that, he said to them, "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep, but I am going so that I may awake him out of sleep." ¹²The disciples therefore said, "Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will recover." ¹³Now Yeshua had spoken of his death, but they thought that he spoke of taking rest in sleep. ¹⁴So Yeshua said to them plainly then, "Lazarus is dead. ¹⁵I am glad for your sakes that I was not there, so that you may believe. Nevertheless, let's go to him." ¹⁶Thomas therefore, who is called Didymus, ^{xxviii} said to his fellow disciples, "Let's also go, that we may die with him." ¹⁷So when Yeshua came, he found that he had been in the tomb four days already. ¹⁸Now Bethany was near Jerusalem, about fifteen stadia ^{xxix} away. ¹⁹Many of the Judeans had joined the women around Martha and Miriam, to console them concerning their brother. ²⁰Then when Martha heard that Yeshua was coming, she went and met him, but Miriam stayed in the house. ²¹Therefore Martha said to Yeshua, "Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn't have died. ²²Even now I know that whatever you ask of God, God will give you." ²³Yeshua said to her, "Your brother will rise again." ²⁴Martha said to him, "I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day." ²⁵Yeshua said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in me will still live, even if he dies. ²⁶Whoever lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?" ²⁷She said to him, "Yes, Lord. I have come to believe that you are the Messiah, God's Son, he who comes into the world." ²⁸When she had said this, she went away and called Miriam, her sister, secretly, saying, "The Rabbi is here and

is calling you." ²⁹When she heard this, she arose quickly and went to him. ³⁰Now Yeshua had not yet come into the village, but was in the place where Martha met him. ³¹Then the Judeans who were with her in the house and were consoling her, when they saw Miriam, that she rose up quickly and went out, followed her, saying, "She is going to the tomb to weep there." ³²Therefore when Miriam came to where Yeshua was and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying to him, "Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn't have died." ³³When Yeshua therefore saw her weeping, and the Judeans weeping who came with her, he groaned in the spirit and was troubled, ³⁴and said, "Where have you laid him?" They told him, "Lord, come and see." ³⁵Yeshua wept. ³⁶The Judeans therefore said, "See how much affection he had for him!" ³⁷Some of them said, "Couldn't this man, who opened the eyes of him who was blind, have also kept this man from dying?" ³⁸Yeshua therefore, again groaning in himself, came to the tomb. Now it was a cave, and a stone lay against it. ³⁹Yeshua said, "Take away the stone." Martha, the sister of him who was dead, said to him, "Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days." ⁴⁰Yeshua said to her, "Didn't I tell you that if you believed, you would see God's glory?" ⁴¹So they took away the stone from the place where the dead man was lying. ^{xxx} Yeshua lifted up his eyes and said, "Father, I thank you that you listened to me. ⁴²I know that you always listen to me, but because of the multitude standing around I said this, that they may believe that you sent me." ⁴³When he had said this, he cried with a loud voice, "Lazarus, come out!" ⁴⁴He who was dead came out, bound hand and foot with wrappings, and his face was wrapped around with a cloth. Yeshua said to them, "Free him, and let him go." ⁴⁵Therefore many of the Judeans who came to Miriam and saw what Yeshua did believed in him. ⁴⁶But some of them went away to the Pharisees and told them the things which Yeshua had done. ⁴⁷The chief priests therefore and the Pharisees gathered a council, and said, "What are we doing? For this man does many signs. ⁴⁸If we leave him alone like this, everyone will believe in him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and our nation." ⁴⁹But a certain one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, "You know nothing at all, ⁵⁰nor do you consider that it is advantageous for us that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation not perish." ⁵¹Now he didn't say this of himself, but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Yeshua would die for the nation, ⁵²and not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad. ⁵³So from that day forward they took counsel that they might put him to death. ⁵⁴Yeshua therefore walked no more openly among the Judeans, but departed from there into the country near the wilderness, to

^{xxviii}Didymus" means "Twin".

^{xxix}15 stadia is about 2.8 kilometers or 1.7 miles

^{xxx}NU omits "from the place where the dead man was lying."

a city called Ephraim. He stayed there with his disciples. ⁵⁵Now the Passover in Judea was at hand. Many went up from the country to Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves. ⁵⁶Then they sought for Yeshua and spoke with one another as they stood in the temple, “What do you think—that he isn’t coming to the feast at all?” ⁵⁷Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had commanded that if anyone knew where he was, he should report it, that they might seize him.

12Then, six days before the Passover, Yeshua came to Bethany, where Lazarus was, who had been dead, whom he raised from the dead. ²So they made him a supper there. Martha served, but Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with him. ³Therefore Miriam took a pound ^{xxxix} of ointment of pure nard, very precious, and anointed Yeshua’s feet and wiped his feet with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the ointment. ⁴Then Judah Iscariot, Simon’s son, one of his disciples, who would betray him, said, ⁵“Why wasn’t this ointment sold for three hundred denarii ^{xxxix} and given to the poor?” ⁶Now he said this, not because he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief, and having the money box, used to steal what was put into it. ⁷But Yeshua said, “Leave her alone. She has kept this for the day of my burial. ⁸For you always have the poor with you, but you don’t always have me.” ⁹A large crowd therefore of the Judeans learned that he was there; and they came, not for Yeshua’s sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead. ¹⁰But the chief priests conspired to put Lazarus to death also, ¹¹because on account of him many of the Judeans went away and believed in Yeshua. ¹²On the next day a great multitude had come to the feast. When they heard that Yeshua was coming to Jerusalem, ¹³they took the branches of the palm trees and went out to meet him, and cried out, “Hoshia’na! ^{xxxix} Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord, the King of Israel!” ¹⁴Yeshua, having found a young donkey, sat on it. As it is written, ¹⁵“Don’t be afraid, daughter of Zion. Behold, your King comes, sitting on a donkey’s colt.” ¹⁶His disciples didn’t understand these things at first, but when Yeshua was glorified, then they remembered that these things were written about him, and that they had done these things to him. ¹⁷The multitude therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of the tomb and raised him from the dead was testifying about it. ¹⁸For this cause also the multitude went and met him, because they heard that he had done this sign. ¹⁹The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, “See how you accomplish nothing. Behold, the world has gone after him.” ²⁰Now there were certain Greeks among those who went up to worship at the feast.

²¹Therefore, these came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida of Galilee, and asked him, saying, “Sir, we want to see Yeshua.” ²²Philip came and told Andrew, and in turn, Andrew came with Philip, and they told Yeshua. ²³Yeshua answered them, “The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified. ²⁴Most certainly I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains by itself alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit. ²⁵He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it to eternal life. ²⁶If anyone serves me, let him follow me. Where I am, there my servant will also be. If anyone serves me, the Father will honor him. ²⁷“Now my soul is troubled. What shall I say? ‘Father, save me from this time?’ But I came to this time for this cause. ²⁸Father, glorify your name!” Then a voice came out of the sky, saying, “I have both glorified it and will glorify it again.” ²⁹Therefore the multitude who stood by and heard it said that it had thundered. Others said, “An angel has spoken to him.” ³⁰Yeshua answered, “This voice hasn’t come for my sake, but for your sakes. ³¹Now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be cast out. ³²And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself.” ³³But he said this, signifying by what kind of death he should die. ³⁴The multitude answered him, “We have heard out of the law that the Messiah remains forever. How do you say, ‘The Son of Man must be lifted up?’ Who is this Son of Man?” ³⁵Yeshua therefore said to them, “Yet a little while the light is with you. Walk while you have the light, that darkness doesn’t overtake you. He who walks in the darkness doesn’t know where he is going. ³⁶Yeshua While you have the light, believe in the light, that you may become children of light.” said these things, and he departed and hid himself from them. ³⁷But though he had done so many signs before them, yet they didn’t believe in him, ³⁸that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spoke: “Lord, who has believed our report? To whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?” ³⁹For this cause they couldn’t believe, for Isaiah said again: ⁴⁰“He has blinded their eyes and he hardened their heart, lest they should see with their eyes, and perceive with their heart, and would turn, and I would heal them.” ⁴¹Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him. ⁴²Nevertheless, even many of the rulers believed in him, but because of the Pharisees they didn’t confess it, so that they wouldn’t be put out of the synagogue, ⁴³for they loved men’s praise more than God’s praise. ⁴⁴Yeshua cried out and said, “Whoever believes in me, believes not in me, but in him who sent me. ⁴⁵He who sees me sees him who sent me. ⁴⁶I have come as a light into the world, that whoever believes in me may not remain in the darkness. ⁴⁷If anyone listens to my sayings and doesn’t believe, I don’t judge him. For I came not to judge the world, but to save the world. ⁴⁸He who rejects me, and doesn’t receive my sayings, has one who judges

^{xxxix}a Roman pound of 12 ounces, or about 340 grams

^{xxxix}300 denarii was about a year’s wages for an agricultural laborer.

^{xxxix}“Hoshia’na” means “save us” or “help us, we pray”.

him. The word that I spoke will judge him in the last day.⁴⁹ For I spoke not from myself, but the Father who sent me gave me a commandment, what I should say and what I should speak.⁵⁰ I know that his commandment is eternal life. The things therefore which I speak, even as the Father has said to me, so I speak.”

13 Now before the feast of the Passover, Yeshua, knowing that his time had come that he would depart from this world to the Father, having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them to the end.² During supper, the devil having already put into the heart of Judah Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him,³ Yeshua, knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he came from God and was going to God,⁴ arose from supper, and laid aside his outer garments. He took a towel and wrapped a towel around his waist.⁵ Then he poured water into the basin, and began to wash the disciples' feet and to wipe them with the towel that was wrapped around him.⁶ Then he came to Simon Peter. He said to him, “Lord, do you wash my feet?”⁷ Yeshua answered him, “You don't know what I am doing now, but you will understand later.”⁸ Peter said to him, “You will never wash my feet!” Yeshua answered him, “If I don't wash you, you have no part with me.”⁹ Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!”¹⁰ Yeshua said to him, “Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed, but is completely clean. You are clean, but not all of you.”¹¹ For he knew him who would betray him; therefore he said, “You are not all clean.”¹² So when he had washed their feet, put his outer garment back on, and sat down again, he said to them, “Do you know what I have done to you?”¹³ You call me, ‘Rabbi’ and ‘Lord.’ You say so correctly, for so I am.¹⁴ If I then, the Lord and the Rabbi, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another's feet.¹⁵ For I have given you an example, that you should also do as I have done to you.¹⁶ Most certainly I tell you, a servant is not greater than his lord, neither is one who is sent greater than he who sent him.¹⁷ If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.¹⁸ I don't speak concerning all of you. I know whom I have chosen; but that the Scripture may be fulfilled, ‘He who eats bread with me has lifted up his heel against me.’¹⁹ From now on, I tell you before it happens, that when it happens, you may believe that I am he.²⁰ Most certainly I tell you, he who receives whomever I send, receives me; and he who receives me, receives him who sent me.”²¹ When Yeshua had said this, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, “Most certainly I tell you that one of you will betray me.”²² The disciples looked at one another, perplexed about whom he spoke.²³ One of his disciples, whom Yeshua loved, was at the table, leaning against Yeshua's breast.²⁴ Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, and said to him, “Tell us who it is of whom he speaks.”²⁵ He, leaning back, as he was, on

Yeshua's breast, asked him, “Lord, who is it?”²⁶ Yeshua therefore answered, “It is he to whom I will give this piece of bread when I have dipped it.” So when he had dipped the piece of bread, he gave it to Judah, the son of Simon Iscariot.²⁷ After the piece of bread, then Satan entered into him. Then Yeshua said to him, “What you do, do quickly.”²⁸ Now nobody at the table knew why he said this to him.²⁹ For some thought, because Judah had the money box, that Yeshua said to him, “Buy what things we need for the feast,” or that he should give something to the poor.³⁰ Therefore having received that morsel, he went out immediately. It was night.³¹ When he had gone out, Yeshua said, “Now the Son of Man has been glorified, and God has been glorified in him.³² If God has been glorified in him, God will also glorify him in himself, and he will glorify him immediately.³³ Little children, I will be with you a little while longer. You will seek me, and as I said to the Judeans, ‘Where I am going, you can't come,’ so now I tell you.³⁴ A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another. Just as I have loved you, you also love one another.³⁵ By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another.”³⁶ Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, where are you going?” Yeshua answered, “Where I am going, you can't follow now, but you will follow afterwards.”³⁷ Peter said to him, “Lord, why can't I follow you now? I will lay down my life for you.”³⁸ Yeshua answered him, “Will you lay down your life for me? Most certainly I tell you, the rooster won't crow until you have denied me three times.

14 “Don't let your heart be troubled. Believe in God. Believe also in me.² In my Father's house are many homes. If it weren't so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you.³ If I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.⁴ You know where I go, and you know the way.”⁵ Thomas said to him, “Lord, we don't know where you are going. How can we know the way?”⁶ Yeshua said to him, “I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father, except through me.⁷ If you had known me, you would have known my Father also. From now on, you know him and have seen him.”⁸ Philip said to him, “Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us.”⁹ Yeshua said to him, “Have I been with you such a long time, and do you not know me, Philip? He who has seen me has seen the Father. How do you say, ‘Show us the Father?’¹⁰ Don't you believe that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? The words that I tell you, I speak not from myself; but the Father who lives in me does his works.¹¹ Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me; or else believe me for the very works' sake.¹² Most certainly I tell you, he who believes in me, the works that I do, he will do also; and he will do greater works than these, because I am going to

my Father. ¹³Whatever you will ask in my name, I will do it, that the Father may be glorified in the Son. ¹⁴If you will ask anything in my name, I will do it. ¹⁵If you love me, keep my commandments. ¹⁶I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, ^{xxxiv} that he may be with you forever: ¹⁷the Spirit of truth, whom the world can't receive, for it doesn't see him and doesn't know him. You know him, for he lives with you and will be in you. ¹⁸I will not leave you orphans. I will come to you. ¹⁹Yet a little while, and the world will see me no more; but you will see me. Because I live, you will live also. ²⁰In that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you in me, and I in you. ²¹One who has my commandments and keeps them, that person is one who loves me. One who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him, and will reveal myself to him." ²²Judah (not Iscariot) said to him, "Lord, what has happened that you are about to reveal yourself to us, and not to the world?" ²³Yeshua answered him, "If a man loves me, he will keep my word. My Father will love him, and we will come to him and make our home with him. ²⁴He who doesn't love me doesn't keep my words. The word which you hear isn't mine, but the Father's who sent me. ²⁵"I have said these things to you while still living with you. ²⁶But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you. ²⁷Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you; not as the world gives, I give to you. Don't let your heart be troubled, neither let it be fearful. ²⁸You heard how I told you, 'I am going away, and I will come back to you.' If you loved me, you would have rejoiced because I said 'I am going to my Father;' for the Father is greater than I. ²⁹Now I have told you before it happens so that when it happens, you may believe. ³⁰I will no more speak much with you, for the prince of the world comes, and he has nothing in me. ³¹But that the world may know that I love the Father, and as the Father commanded me, even so I do. Arise, let's go from here.

15 "I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer. ²Every branch in me that doesn't bear fruit, he takes away. Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes, that it may bear more fruit. ³You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you. ⁴Remain in me, and I in you. As the branch can't bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, so neither can you, unless you remain in me. ⁵I am the vine. You are the branches. He who remains in me and I in him bears much fruit, for apart from me you can do nothing. ⁶If a man doesn't remain in me, he is thrown out as a branch and is withered; and they gather them, throw them into the fire, and they are burned. ⁷If you remain in me, and my words remain in

you, you will ask whatever you desire, and it will be done for you. ⁸"In this my Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit; and so you will be my disciples. ⁹Even as the Father has loved me, I also have loved you. Remain in my love. ¹⁰If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love, even as I have kept my Father's commandments and remain in his love. ¹¹I have spoken these things to you, that my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full. ¹²"This is my commandment, that you love one another, even as I have loved you. ¹³Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends. ¹⁴You are my friends if you do whatever I command you. ¹⁵No longer do I call you servants, for the servant doesn't know what his lord does. But I have called you friends, for everything that I heard from my Father, I have made known to you. ¹⁶You didn't choose me, but I chose you and appointed you, that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain; that whatever you will ask of the Father in my name, he may give it to you. ¹⁷"I command these things to you, that you may love one another. ¹⁸If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you. ¹⁹If you were of the world, the world would love its own. But because you are not of the world, since I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you. ²⁰Remember the word that I said to you: 'A servant is not greater than his lord.' If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you. If they kept my word, they will also keep yours. ²¹But they will do all these things to you for my name's sake, because they don't know him who sent me. ²²If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have had sin; but now they have no excuse for their sin. ²³He who hates me, hates my Father also. ²⁴If I hadn't done among them the works which no one else did, they wouldn't have had sin. But now they have seen and also hated both me and my Father. ²⁵But this happened so that the word may be fulfilled which was written in their law, 'They hated me without a cause.' ²⁶"When the Counselor ^{xxxv} has come, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, he will testify about me. ²⁷You will also testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.

16 "I have said these things to you so that you wouldn't be caused to stumble. ²They will put you out of the synagogues. Yes, the time is coming that whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God. ³They will do these things ^{xxxvi} because they have not known the Father nor me. ⁴But I have told you these things so that when the time comes, you may remember that I told you about them. I didn't tell you these things from the beginning,

^{xxxiv}Greek : Counselor, Helper, Intercessor, Advocate, and Comforter.

^{xxxv}Greek Parakletos: Counselor, Helper, Advocate, Intercessor, and Comforter.

^{xxxvi}TR adds "to you"

because I was with you. ⁵But now I am going to him who sent me, and none of you asks me, 'Where are you going?' ⁶But because I have told you these things, sorrow has filled your heart. ⁷Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away; for if I don't go away, the Counselor won't come to you. But if I go, I will send him to you. ⁸When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment; ⁹about sin, because they don't believe in me; ¹⁰about righteousness, because I am going to my Father, and you won't see me any more; ¹¹about judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged. ¹²" I still have many things to tell you, but you can't bear them now. ¹³However, when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming. ¹⁴He will glorify me, for he will take from what is mine and will declare it to you. ¹⁵All things that the Father has are mine; therefore I said that he takes ^{xxxvii} of mine and will declare it to you. ¹⁶" A little while, and you will not see me. Again a little while, and you will see me." ¹⁷Some of his disciples therefore said to one another, "What is this that he says to us, 'A little while, and you won't see me, and again a little while, and you will see me;' and, '?' Because I go to the Father' ¹⁸They said therefore, "What is this that he says, '?' A little while' We don't know what he is saying." ¹⁹Therefore Yeshua perceived that they wanted to ask him, and he said to them, " Do you inquire among yourselves concerning this, that I said, 'A little while, and you won't see me, and again a little while, and you will see me?' ²⁰Most certainly I tell you that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. You will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy. ²¹A woman, when she gives birth, has sorrow because her time has come. But when she has delivered the child, she doesn't remember the anguish any more, for the joy that a human being is born into the world. ²²Therefore you now have sorrow, but I will see you again, and your heart will rejoice, and no one will take your joy away from you. ²³" In that day you will ask me no questions. Most certainly I tell you, whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you. ²⁴Until now, you have asked nothing in my name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be made full. ²⁵" I have spoken these things to you in figures of speech. But the time is coming when I will no more speak to you in figures of speech, but will tell you plainly about the Father. ²⁶In that day you will ask in my name; and I don't say to you that I will pray to the Father for you, ²⁷for the Father himself loves you, because you have loved me, and have believed that I came from God. ²⁸I came from the Father and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world and go to the Father." ²⁹His disciples said to him, "Behold, now you are speaking

plainly, and using no figures of speech. ³⁰Now we know that you know all things, and don't need for anyone to question you. By this we believe that you came from God." ³¹Yeshua answered them, " Do you now believe? ³²Behold, the time is coming, yes, and has now come, that you will be scattered, everyone to his own place, and you will leave me alone. Yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me. ³³I have told you these things, that in me you may have peace. In the world you have trouble; but cheer up! I have overcome the world."

17Yeshua said these things, then lifting up his eyes to heaven, he said, " Father, the time has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may also glorify you; ²even as you gave him authority over all flesh, so he will give eternal life to all whom you have given him. ³This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent, Yeshua the Messiah. ⁴I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do. ⁵Now, Father, glorify me with your own self with the glory which I had with you before the world existed. ⁶" I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me out of the world. They were yours, and you have given them to me. They have kept your word. ⁷Now they have known that all things whatever you have given me are from you, ⁸for the words which you have given me I have given to them; and they received them, and knew for sure that I came from you. They have believed that you sent me. ⁹I pray for them. I don't pray for the world, but for those whom you have given me, for they are yours. ¹⁰All things that are mine are yours, and yours are mine, and I am glorified in them. ¹¹I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, keep them through your name which you have given me, that they may be one, even as we are. ¹²While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. I have kept those whom you have given me. None of them is lost except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled. ¹³But now I come to you, and I say these things in the world, that they may have my joy made full in themselves. ¹⁴I have given them your word. The world hated them because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world. ¹⁵I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one. ¹⁶They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world. ¹⁷Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth. ¹⁸As you sent me into the world, even so I have sent them into the world. ¹⁹For their sakes I sanctify myself, that they themselves also may be sanctified in truth. ²⁰" Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who will believe in me through their word, ²¹that they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me. ²²The glory which you have given me,

^{xxxvii}TR reads "will take" instead of "takes"

I have given to them, that they may be one, even as we are one, ²³I in them, and you in me, that they may be perfected into one, that the world may know that you sent me and loved them, even as you loved me. ²⁴Father, I desire that they also whom you have given me be with me where I am, that they may see my glory which you have given me, for you loved me before the foundation of the world. ²⁵Righteous Father, the world hasn't known you, but I knew you; and these knew that you sent me. ²⁶I made known to them your name, and will make it known; that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them."

18When Yeshua had spoken these words, he went out with his disciples over the brook Kidron, where there was a garden, into which he and his disciples entered. ²Now Judah, who betrayed him, also knew the place, for Yeshua often met there with his disciples. ³Judah then, having taken a detachment of soldiers and officers from the chief priests and the Pharisees, came there with lanterns, torches, and weapons. ⁴Yeshua therefore, knowing all the things that were happening to him, went out and said to them, "Who are you looking for?" ⁵They answered him, "Yeshua of Nazareth." Yeshua said to them, "I am he." Judah also, who betrayed him, was standing with them. ⁶When therefore he said to them, "I am he," they went backward and fell to the ground. ⁷Again therefore he asked them, "Who are you looking for?" They said, "Yeshua of Nazareth." ⁸Yeshua answered, "I told you that I am he. If therefore you seek me, let these go their way," ⁹that the word might be fulfilled which he spoke, "Of those whom you have given me, I have lost none." ¹⁰Simon Peter therefore, having a sword, drew it, struck the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus. ¹¹Yeshua therefore said to Peter, "Put the sword into its sheath. The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not surely drink it?" ¹²So the detachment, the commanding officer, and the officers of the Jews seized Yeshua and bound him, ¹³and led him to Annas first, for he was father-in-law to Caiaphas, who was high priest that year. ¹⁴Now it was Caiaphas who advised the Judeans that it was expedient that one man should perish for the people. ¹⁵Simon Peter followed Yeshua, as did another disciple. Now that disciple was known to the high priest, and entered in with Yeshua into the court of the high priest; ¹⁶but Peter was standing at the door outside. So the other disciple, who was known to the high priest, went out and spoke to her who kept the door, and brought in Peter. ¹⁷Then the maid who kept the door said to Peter, "Are you also one of this man's disciples?" He said, "I am not." ¹⁸Now the servants and the officers were standing there, having made a fire of coals, for it was cold. They were warming themselves. Peter was with them, standing and warming himself. ¹⁹The high priest therefore asked Yeshua about his disciples and

about his teaching. ²⁰Yeshua answered him, "I spoke openly to the world. I always taught in synagogues and in the temple, where the Jews always meet. I said nothing in secret. ²¹Why do you ask me? Ask those who have heard me what I said to them. Behold, they know the things which I said." ²²When he had said this, one of the officers standing by slapped Yeshua with his hand, saying, "Do you answer the high priest like that?" ²³Yeshua answered him, "If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil; but if well, why do you beat me?" ²⁴Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas, the high priest. ²⁵Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They said therefore to him, "You aren't also one of his disciples, are you?" He denied it and said, "I am not." ²⁶One of the servants of the high priest, being a relative of him whose ear Peter had cut off, said, "Didn't I see you in the garden with him?" ²⁷Peter therefore denied it again, and immediately the rooster crowed. ²⁸They led Yeshua therefore from Caiaphas into the Praetorium. It was early, and they themselves didn't enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover. ²⁹Pilate therefore went out to them and said, "What accusation do you bring against this man?" ³⁰They answered him, "If this man weren't an evildoer, we wouldn't have delivered him up to you." ³¹Pilate therefore said to them, "Take him yourselves, and judge him according to your law." Therefore the Judeans said to him, "It is illegal for us to put anyone to death," ³²that the word of Yeshua might be fulfilled, which he spoke, signifying by what kind of death he should die. ³³Pilate therefore entered again into the Praetorium, called Yeshua, and said to him, "Are you the King of the Jews?" ³⁴Yeshua answered him, "Do you say this by yourself, or did others tell you about me?" ³⁵Pilate answered, "I'm not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests delivered you to me. What have you done?" ³⁶Yeshua answered, "My Kingdom is not of this world. If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight, that I wouldn't be delivered to the Judeans. But now my Kingdom is not from here." ³⁷Pilate therefore said to him, "Are you a king then?" Yeshua answered, "You say that I am a king. For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice." ³⁸Pilate said to him, "What is truth?" When he had said this, he went out again to the Judeans, and said to them, "I find no basis for a charge against him. ³⁹But you have a custom that I should release someone to you at the Passover. Therefore, do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?" ⁴⁰Then they all shouted again, saying, "Not this man, but Barabbas!" Now Barabbas was a robber.

19So Pilate then took Yeshua and flogged him. ²The soldiers twisted thorns into a crown and put it on his head, and dressed him in a purple garment. ³They kept saying,

“Hail, King of the Jews!” and they kept slapping him. ⁴Then Pilate went out again, and said to them, “Behold, I bring him out to you, that you may know that I find no basis for a charge against him.” ⁵Yeshua therefore came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple garment. Pilate said to them, “Behold, the man!” ⁶When therefore the chief priests and the officers saw him, they shouted, saying, “Crucify! Crucify!” Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves and crucify him, for I find no basis for a charge against him.” ⁷The Judeans answered him, “We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.” ⁸When therefore Pilate heard this saying, he was more afraid. ⁹He entered into the Praetorium again, and said to Yeshua, “Where are you from?” But Yeshua gave him no answer. ¹⁰Pilate therefore said to him, “Aren’t you speaking to me? Don’t you know that I have power to release you and have power to crucify you?” ¹¹Yeshua answered, “You would have no power at all against me, unless it were given to you from above. Therefore he who delivered me to you has greater sin.” ¹²At this, Pilate was seeking to release him, but the Judeans cried out, saying, “If you release this man, you aren’t Caesar’s friend! Everyone who makes himself a king speaks against Caesar!” ¹³When Pilate therefore heard these words, he brought Yeshua out and sat down on the judgment seat at a place called “The Pavement”, but in Hebrew, “Gabbatha.” ¹⁴Now it was the Preparation Day of the Passover, at about the sixth hour. ^{xxxviii} He said to the Judeans, “Behold, your King!” ¹⁵They cried out, “Away with him! Away with him! Crucify him!” Pilate said to them, “Shall I crucify your King?” The chief priests answered, “We have no king but Caesar!” ¹⁶So then he delivered him to them to be crucified. So they took Yeshua and led him away. ¹⁷He went out, bearing his cross, to the place called “The Place of a Skull”, which is called in Hebrew, “Golgotha”, ¹⁸where they crucified him, and with him two others, on either side one, and Yeshua in the middle. ¹⁹Pilate wrote a title also, and put it on the cross. There was written, “YESHUA OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS.” ²⁰Therefore many of the Judeans read this title, for the place where Yeshua was crucified was near the city; and it was written in Hebrew, in Latin, and in Greek. ²¹The chief priests of the Judeans therefore said to Pilate, “Don’t write, ‘The King of the Jews,’ but, ‘he said, “I am King of the Jews.””” ²²Pilate answered, “What I have written, I have written.” ²³Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Yeshua, took his garments and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also the tunic. Now the tunic was without seam, woven from the top throughout. ²⁴Then they said to one another, “Let’s not tear it, but cast lots for it to decide

whose it will be,” that the Scripture might be fulfilled, which says, “They parted my garments among them. They cast lots for my clothing.” Therefore the soldiers did these things. ²⁵But standing by Yeshua’s cross were his mother, his mother’s sister, Miriam the wife of Klofah, and Miriam Magdalene. ²⁶Therefore when Yeshua saw his mother, and the disciple whom he loved standing there, he said to his mother, “Woman, behold, your son!” ²⁷Then he said to the disciple, “Behold, your mother!” From that hour, the disciple took her to his own home. ²⁸After this, Yeshua, seeing ^{xxxix} that all things were now finished, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, said, “I am thirsty!” ²⁹Now a vessel full of vinegar was set there; so they put a sponge full of the vinegar on hyssop, and held it at his mouth. ³⁰When Yeshua therefore had received the vinegar, he said, “It is finished!” Then he bowed his head and gave up his spirit. ³¹Therefore the Judeans, because it was the Preparation Day, so that the bodies wouldn’t remain on the cross on the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was a special one), asked of Pilate that their legs might be broken and that they might be taken away. ³²Therefore the soldiers came and broke the legs of the first and of the other who was crucified with him; ³³but when they came to Yeshua and saw that he was already dead, they didn’t break his legs. ³⁴However, one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out. ³⁵He who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true. He knows that he tells the truth, that you may believe. ³⁶For these things happened that the Scripture might be fulfilled, “A bone of him will not be broken.” ³⁷Again another Scripture says, “They will look on him whom they pierced.” ³⁸After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Yeshua, but secretly for fear of the Judeans, asked of Pilate that he might take away Yeshua’s body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. ³⁹Nicodemus, who at first came to Yeshua by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds. ^{xl} ⁴⁰So they took Yeshua’s body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Judeans is to bury. ⁴¹Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. ⁴²Then, because of the Judeans’ Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand), they laid Yeshua there.

20 Now on the first day of the week, Miriam Magdalene went early, while it was still dark, to the tomb, and saw that the stone had been taken away from the tomb. ²Therefore she ran and came to Simon Peter and to the other disciple whom Yeshua loved, and said to them, “They have taken away the Lord out of the tomb, and we don’t

^{xxxviii}the sixth hour” would have been 6:00 a.m. according to the Roman timekeeping system, or noon for the Jewish timekeeping system in use, then.

^{xxxix}NU, TR read “knowing” instead of “seeing”

^{xl}100 Roman pounds of 12 ounces each, or about 72 pounds, or 33 Kilograms.

know where they have laid him!" ³Therefore Peter and the other disciple went out, and they went toward the tomb. ⁴They both ran together. The other disciple outran Peter and came to the tomb first. ⁵Stooping and looking in, he saw the linen cloths lying there; yet he didn't enter in. ⁶Then Simon Peter came, following him, and entered into the tomb. He saw the linen cloths lying, ⁷and the cloth that had been on his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but rolled up in a place by itself. ⁸So then the other disciple who came first to the tomb also entered in, and he saw and believed. ⁹For as yet they didn't know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead. ¹⁰So the disciples went away again to their own homes. ¹¹But Miriam was standing outside at the tomb weeping. So as she wept, she stooped and looked into the tomb, ¹²and she saw two angels in white sitting, one at the head and one at the feet, where the body of Yeshua had lain. ¹³They asked her, "Woman, why are you weeping?" She said to them, "Because they have taken away my Lord, and I don't know where they have laid him." ¹⁴When she had said this, she turned around and saw Yeshua standing, and didn't know that it was Yeshua. ¹⁵Yeshua said to her, "Woman, why are you weeping? Who are you looking for?" She, supposing him to be the gardener, said to him, "Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away." ¹⁶Yeshua said to her, "Miriam." She turned and said to him, "Rabboni!" ^{xli} which is to say, "Rabbi!" ^{xlii} ¹⁷Yeshua said to her, "Don't hold me, for I haven't yet ascended to my Father; but go to my brothers and tell them, 'I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.'" ¹⁸Miriam Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had said these things to her. ¹⁹When therefore it was evening on that day, the first day of the week, and when the doors were locked where the disciples were assembled, for fear of the Judeans, Yeshua came and stood in the middle and said to them, "Peace be to you." ²⁰When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore were glad when they saw the Lord. ²¹Yeshua therefore said to them again, "Peace be to you. As the Father has sent me, even so I send you." ²²When he had said this, he breathed on them, and said to them, "Receive the Holy Spirit! ²³If you forgive anyone's sins, they have been forgiven them. If you retain anyone's sins, they have been retained." ²⁴But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, ^{xliii} wasn't with them when Yeshua came. ²⁵The other disciples therefore said to him, "We have seen the Lord!" But he said to them, "Unless I see in his hands the print of the nails, put my finger into the print of the nails, and put my hand into

his side, I will not believe." ²⁶After eight days, again his disciples were inside and Thomas was with them. Yeshua came, the doors being locked, and stood in the middle, and said, "Peace be to you." ²⁷Then he said to Thomas, "Reach here your finger, and see my hands. Reach here your hand, and put it into my side. Don't be unbelieving, but believing." ²⁸Thomas answered him, "My Lord and my God!" ²⁹Yeshua said to him, "Because you have seen me, ^{xliv} you have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen and have believed." ³⁰Therefore Yeshua did many other signs in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book; ³¹but these are written that you may believe that Yeshua is the Messiah, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.

21After these things, Yeshua revealed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias. He revealed himself this way. ²Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus, ^{xlv} Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples were together. ³Simon Peter said to them, "I'm going fishing." They told him, "We are also coming with you." They immediately went out and entered into the boat. That night, they caught nothing. ⁴But when day had already come, Yeshua stood on the beach; yet the disciples didn't know that it was Yeshua. ⁵Yeshua therefore said to them, "Children, have you anything to eat?" They answered him, "No." ⁶He said to them, "Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some." They cast it therefore, and now they weren't able to draw it in for the multitude of fish. ⁷That disciple therefore whom Yeshua loved said to Peter, "It's the Lord!" So when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he wrapped his coat around himself (for he was naked), and threw himself into the sea. ⁸But the other disciples came in the little boat (for they were not far from the land, but about two hundred cubits ^{xlvi} away), dragging the net full of fish. ⁹So when they got out on the land, they saw a fire of coals there, with fish and bread laid on it. ¹⁰Yeshua said to them, "Bring some of the fish which you have just caught." ¹¹Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land, full of one hundred fifty-three great fish. Even though there were so many, the net wasn't torn. ¹²Yeshua said to them, "Come and eat breakfast!" None of the disciples dared inquire of him, "Who are you?" knowing that it was the Lord. ¹³Then Yeshua came and took the bread, gave it to them, and the fish likewise. ¹⁴This is now the third time that Yeshua was revealed to his disciples after he had risen from the dead. ¹⁵So when they had eaten their breakfast, Yeshua said to Simon Peter, "Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me more than these?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you."

^{xli}Rabboni is a transliteration of the Hebrew word for "great teacher."

^{xlii}or, Master

^{xliii}or, Twin

^{xliv}TR adds "Thomas,"

^{xlv}or, Twin

^{xlvi}200 cubits is about 100 yards or about 91 meters

He said to him, “Feed my lambs.”¹⁶ He said to him again a second time, “Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me?” He said to him, “Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you.” He said to him, “Tend my sheep.”¹⁷ He said to him the third time, “Simon, son of Jonah, do you have affection for me?” Peter was grieved because he asked him the third time, “Do you have affection for me?” He said to him, “Lord, you know everything. You know that I have affection for you.” Yeshua said to him, “Feed my sheep.¹⁸ Most certainly I tell you, when you were young, you dressed yourself and walked where you wanted to. But when you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will dress you and carry you where you don’t want to go.”¹⁹ Now he said this, signifying by what kind of death he would glorify God. When he had said this, he said to him, “Follow me.”²⁰ Then Peter, turning around, saw a disciple following. This was the disciple whom Yeshua loved, the one who had also leaned on Yeshua’s breast at the supper and asked, “Lord, who is going to betray you?”²¹ Peter, seeing him, said to Yeshua, “Lord, what about this man?”²² Yeshua said to him, “If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you? You follow me.”²³ This saying therefore went out among the brothers^{xlvi} that this disciple wouldn’t die. Yet Yeshua didn’t say to him that he wouldn’t die, but, “If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you?”²⁴ This is the disciple who testifies about these things, and wrote these things. We know that his witness is true.²⁵ There are also many other things which Yeshua did, which if they would all be written, I suppose that even the world itself wouldn’t have room for the books that would be written.

^{xlvi}The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

Acts

¹The first book I wrote, Theophilus, concerned all that Yeshua began both to do and to teach, ²until the day in which he was received up, after he had given commandment through the Holy Spirit to the emissaries whom he had chosen. ³To these he also showed himself alive after he suffered, by many proofs, appearing to them over a period of forty days and speaking about God's Kingdom. ⁴Being assembled together with them, he commanded them, "Don't depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which you heard from me. ⁵For Yochanan indeed immersed in water, but you will be immersed in the Holy Spirit not many days from now." ⁶Therefore, when they had come together, they asked him, "Lord, are you now restoring the kingdom to Israel?" ⁷He said to them, "It isn't for you to know times or seasons which the Father has set within his own authority. ⁸But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost parts of the earth." ⁹When he had said these things, as they were looking, he was taken up, and a cloud received him out of their sight. ¹⁰While they were looking steadfastly into the sky as he went, behold, ⁱ two men stood by them in white clothing, ¹¹who also said, "You men of Galilee, why do you stand looking into the sky? This Yeshua, who was received up from you into the sky, will come back in the same way as you saw him going into the sky." ¹²Then they returned to Jerusalem from the mountain called Olivet, which is near Jerusalem, a Sabbath day's journey away. ¹³When they had come in, they went up into the upper room where they were staying, that is Peter, Yochanan, Jacob, Andrew, Philip, Thomas, Bartholomew, Matthew, Jacob the son of Halfai, Simon the Zealot, and Judah the son of Jacob. ¹⁴All these with one accord continued steadfastly in prayer and supplication, along with the women and Miriam the mother of Yeshua, and with his brothers. ¹⁵In these days, Peter stood up in the middle of the disciples (and the number of names was about one hundred twenty), and said, ¹⁶"Brothers, it was necessary that this Scripture should be fulfilled, which the Holy Spirit spoke before by the mouth of David con-

cerning Judah, who was guide to those who took Yeshua. ¹⁷For he was counted with us, and received his portion in this ministry. ¹⁸Now this man obtained a field with the reward for his wickedness; and falling headlong, his body burst open and all his intestines gushed out. ¹⁹It became known to everyone who lived in Jerusalem that in their language that field was called 'Hakel-Dema,' that is, 'The field of blood.' ²⁰For it is written in the scroll of Psalms, 'Let his habitation be made desolate. Let no one dwell in it;' and, 'Let another take his office.' ²¹"Of the men therefore who have accompanied us all the time that the Lord Yeshua went in and out among us, ²²beginning from the immersion of Yochanan to the day that he was received up from us, of these one must become a witness with us of his resurrection." ²³They put forward two: Joseph called Barsabbas, who was also called Justus, and Matthiah. ²⁴They prayed and said, "You, Lord, who know the hearts of all men, show which one of these two you have chosen ²⁵to take part in this ministry and office of emissary from which Judah fell away, that he might go to his own place." ²⁶They drew lots for them, and the lot fell on Matthiah; and he was counted with the Eleven emissaries.

²Now when the day of Shavu'ot had come, they were all with one accord in one place. ²Suddenly there came from the sky a sound like the rushing of a mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. ³Tongues like fire appeared and were distributed to them, and one sat on each of them. ⁴They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak with other languages, as the Spirit gave them the ability to speak. ⁵Now there were dwelling in Jerusalem Jews, devout men, from every nation under the sky. ⁶When this sound was heard, the multitude came together and were bewildered, because everyone heard them speaking in his own language. ⁷They were all amazed and marveled, saying to one another, "Behold, aren't all these who speak Galileans? ⁸How do we hear, everyone in our own native language? ⁹Parthians, Medes, Elamites, and people from Mesopotamia, Judea, Cappadocia, Pontus, Asia, ¹⁰Phrygia, Pamphylia, Egypt, the parts of Libya around Cyrene, visitors from Rome, both Jews and proselytes, ¹¹Cretans and Arabians—we hear them speaking in our languages the mighty works of

ⁱ"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

God!" ¹²They were all amazed and were perplexed, saying to one another, "What does this mean?" ¹³Others, mocking, said, "They are filled with new wine." ¹⁴But Peter, standing up with the Eleven, lifted up his voice and spoke out to them, "You men of Judea and all you who dwell at Jerusalem, let this be known to you, and listen to my words. ¹⁵For these aren't drunken, as you suppose, seeing it is only the third hour of the day. ⁱⁱ ¹⁶But this is what has been spoken through the prophet Joel: ¹⁷'It will be in the last days, says God, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh. Your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your young men will see visions. Your old men will dream dreams. ¹⁸Yes, and on my servants and on my handmaidens in those days, I will pour out my Spirit, and they will prophesy. ¹⁹I will show wonders in the sky above, and signs on the earth beneath: blood, and fire, and billows of smoke. ²⁰The sun will be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before the great and glorious day of the Lord comes. ²¹It will be that whoever will call on the name of the Lord will be saved.' ²²'Men of Israel, hear these words! Yeshua of Nazareth, a man approved by God to you by mighty works and wonders and signs which God did by him among you, even as you yourselves know, ²³him, being delivered up by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God, you have taken by the hand of lawless men, crucified and killed; ²⁴whom God raised up, having freed him from the agony of death, because it was not possible that he should be held by it. ²⁵For David says concerning him, 'I saw the Lord always before my face, for he is on my right hand, that I should not be moved. ²⁶Therefore my heart was glad, and my tongue rejoiced. Moreover my flesh also will dwell in hope, ²⁷because you will not leave my soul in Sheol, ⁱⁱⁱ neither will you allow your Holy One to see decay. ²⁸You made known to me the ways of life. You will make me full of gladness with your presence.' ²⁹'Brothers, I may tell you freely of the patriarch David, that he both died and was buried, and his tomb is with us to this day. ³⁰Therefore, being a prophet, and knowing that God had sworn with an oath to him that of the fruit of his body, according to the flesh, he would raise up the Messiah ^{iv} to sit on his throne, ³¹he foreseeing this, spoke about the resurrection of the Messiah, that his soul wasn't left in Sheol, ^v and his flesh didn't see decay. ³²This Yeshua God raised up, to which we all are witnesses. ³³Being therefore exalted by the right hand of God, and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he has poured out this which you now see and hear. ³⁴For David didn't ascend into the heavens, but he says himself, 'The Lord said to my Lord, "Sit by my right hand ³⁵until I make your enemies a footstool for

your feet.'" ³⁶'Let all the house of Israel therefore know certainly that God has made him both Lord and Messiah, this Yeshua whom you crucified." ³⁷Now when they heard this, they were cut to the heart, and said to Peter and the rest of the emissaries, "Brothers, what shall we do?" ³⁸Peter said to them, "Repent and be immersed, every one of you, in the name of Yeshua the Messiah for the forgiveness of sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. ³⁹For the promise is to you and to your children, and to all who are far off, even as many as the Lord our God will call to himself." ⁴⁰With many other words he testified and exhorted them, saying, "Save yourselves from this crooked generation!" ⁴¹Then those who gladly received his word were immersed. There were added that day about three thousand souls. ⁴²They continued steadfastly in the emissaries' teaching and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and prayer. ⁴³Fear came on every soul, and many wonders and signs were done through the emissaries. ⁴⁴All who believed were together, and had all things in common. ⁴⁵They sold their possessions and goods, and distributed them to all, according as anyone had need. ⁴⁶Day by day, continuing steadfastly with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread at home, they took their food with gladness and singleness of heart, ⁴⁷praising God and having favor with all the people. The Lord added to the assembly day by day those who were being saved.

3 Peter and Yochanan were going up into the temple at the hour of prayer, the ninth hour. ^{vi} ²A certain man who was lame from his mother's womb was being carried, whom they laid daily at the door of the temple which is called Yafeh ^{vii}, Beautiful to ask gifts for the needy of those who entered into the temple. ³Seeing Peter and Yochanan about to go into the temple, he asked to receive gifts for the needy. ⁴Peter, fastening his eyes on him, with Yochanan, said, "Look at us." ⁵He listened to them, expecting to receive something from them. ⁶But Peter said, "I have no silver or gold, but what I have, that I give you. In the name of Yeshua the Messiah of Nazareth, get up and walk!" ⁷He took him by the right hand and raised him up. Immediately his feet and his ankle bones received strength. ⁸Leaping up, he stood and began to walk. He entered with them into the temple, walking, leaping, and praising God. ⁹All the people saw him walking and praising God. ¹⁰They recognized him, that it was he who used to sit begging for gifts for the needy at the Yafeh Gate of the temple. They were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him. ¹¹As the lame man who was healed held on to Peter and Yochanan, all the people ran together to them in the porch that is called Solomon's, greatly wondering. ¹²When Peter saw it, he responded to the people, "You men of Israel, why do you marvel at this

ⁱⁱabout 9:00 a.m.

ⁱⁱⁱor, Hell

^{iv}"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

^vor, Hell

^{vi}3:00 p.m.

^{vii}Beautiful,

man? Why do you fasten your eyes on us, as though by our own power or godliness we had made him walk? ¹³The God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, the God of our fathers, has glorified his Servant Yeshua, whom you delivered up and denied in the presence of Pilate, when he had determined to release him. ¹⁴But you denied the Holy and Righteous One and asked for a murderer to be granted to you, ¹⁵and killed the Prince of life, whom God raised from the dead, to which we are witnesses. ¹⁶By faith in his name, his name has made this man strong, whom you see and know. Yes, the faith which is through him has given him this perfect soundness in the presence of you all. ¹⁷“Now, brothers, ^{viii} I know that you did this in ignorance, as did also your rulers. ¹⁸But the things which God announced by the mouth of all his prophets, that Messiah should suffer, he thus fulfilled. ¹⁹“Repent therefore, and turn again, that your sins may be blotted out, so that there may come times of refreshing from the presence of the Lord, ²⁰and that he may send Messiah Yeshua, who was ordained for you before, ²¹whom heaven must receive until the times of restoration of all things, which God spoke long ago by the mouth of his holy prophets. ²²For Moses indeed said to the fathers, ‘The Lord God will raise up a prophet for you from among your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him in all things whatever he says to you. ²³It will be that every soul that will not listen to that prophet will be utterly destroyed from among the people.’ ²⁴Yes, and all the prophets from Samuel and those who followed after, as many as have spoken, also told of these days. ²⁵You are the children of the prophets, and of the covenant which God made with our fathers, saying to Abraham, ‘All the families of the earth will be blessed through your offspring.’ ^{ix} ²⁶God, having raised up his servant Yeshua, sent him to you first to bless you, in turning away every one of you from your wickedness.”

⁴As they spoke to the people, the priests and the captain of the temple and the Sadducees came to them, ²being upset because they taught the people and proclaimed in Yeshua the resurrection from the dead. ³They laid hands on them, and put them in custody until the next day, for it was now evening. ⁴But many of those who heard the word believed, and the number of the men came to be about five thousand. ⁵In the morning, their rulers, elders, and scribes were gathered together in Jerusalem. ⁶Annas the high priest was there, with Caiaphas, Yochanan, Alexander, and as many as were relatives of the high priest. ⁷When they had stood Peter and Yochanan in the middle of them, they inquired, “By what power, or in what name, have you done this?” ⁸Then Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said to them, “You rulers of the people and elders of Israel, ⁹if

we are examined today concerning a good deed done to a crippled man, by what means this man has been healed, ¹⁰may it be known to you all, and to all the people of Israel, that in the name of Yeshua the Messiah of Nazareth, whom you crucified, whom God raised from the dead, this man stands here before you whole in him. ¹¹He is ‘the stone which was regarded as worthless by you, the builders, which has become the head of the corner.’ ¹²There is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven that is given among men, by which we must be saved!” ¹³Now when they saw the boldness of Peter and Yochanan, and had perceived that they were unlearned and ignorant men, they marveled. They recognized that they had been with Yeshua. ¹⁴Seeing the man who was healed standing with them, they could say nothing against it. ¹⁵But when they had commanded them to go aside out of the council, they conferred among themselves, ¹⁶saying, “What shall we do to these men? Because indeed a notable miracle has been done through them, as can be plainly seen by all who dwell in Jerusalem, and we can’t deny it. ¹⁷But so that this spreads no further among the people, let’s threaten them, that from now on they don’t speak to anyone in this name.” ¹⁸They called them, and commanded them not to speak at all nor teach in the name of Yeshua. ¹⁹But Peter and Yochanan answered them, “Whether it is right in the sight of God to listen to you rather than to God, judge for yourselves, ²⁰for we can’t help telling the things which we saw and heard.” ²¹When they had further threatened them, they let them go, finding no way to punish them, because of the people; for everyone glorified God for that which was done. ²²For the man on whom this miracle of healing was performed was more than forty years old. ²³Being let go, they came to their own company and reported all that the chief priests and the elders had said to them. ²⁴When they heard it, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord and said, “O Lord, you are God, who made the heaven, the earth, the sea, and all that is in them; ²⁵who by the mouth of your servant David, said, ‘Why do the nations rage, and the peoples plot a vain thing? ²⁶The kings of the earth take a stand, and the rulers take council together, against the Lord, and against his Messiah.’ ^x ²⁷“For truly, ^{xi} both Herod and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles and the people of Israel, were gathered together against your holy servant Yeshua, whom you anointed, ²⁸to do whatever your hand and your council foreordained to happen. ²⁹Now, Lord, look at their threats, and grant to your servants to speak your word with all boldness, ³⁰while you stretch out your hand to heal; and that signs and wonders may be done through the name of your holy Servant Yeshua.” ³¹When they had prayed, the place was shaken where they were gathered together. They were all filled with the Holy Spirit, and they spoke the word of God with

^{viii}The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

^{ix}or, seed

^xChrist (Greek) and Messiah (Hebrew) both mean Anointed One.

^{xi}nu adds “in this city,”

boldness. ³²The multitude of those who believed were of one heart and soul. Not one of them claimed that anything of the things which he possessed was his own, but they had all things in common. ³³With great power, the emissaries gave their testimony of the resurrection of the Lord Yeshua. Great grace was on them all. ³⁴For neither was there among them any who lacked, for as many as were owners of lands or houses sold them, and brought the proceeds of the things that were sold, ³⁵and laid them at the emissaries' feet; and distribution was made to each, according as anyone had need. ³⁶Yosi, who by the emissaries was also called Barnabas (which is, being interpreted, Son of Encouragement), a Levite, a man of Cyprus by race, ³⁷having a field, sold it and brought the money and laid it at the emissaries' feet.

⁵But a certain man named Hananiah, with Shappirah his wife, sold a possession, ²and kept back part of the price, his wife also being aware of it, then brought a certain part and laid it at the emissaries' feet. ³But Peter said, "Hananiah, why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit and to keep back part of the price of the land? ⁴While you kept it, didn't it remain your own? After it was sold, wasn't it in your power? How is it that you have conceived this thing in your heart? You haven't lied to men, but to God." ⁵Hananiah, hearing these words, fell down and died. Great fear came on all who heard these things. ⁶The young men arose and wrapped him up, and they carried him out and buried him. ⁷About three hours later, his wife, not knowing what had happened, came in. ⁸Peter answered her, "Tell me whether you sold the land for so much." She said, "Yes, for so much." ⁹But Peter asked her, "How is it that you have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord? Behold, the feet of those who have buried your husband are at the door, and they will carry you out." ¹⁰She fell down immediately at his feet and died. The young men came in and found her dead, and they carried her out and buried her by her husband. ¹¹Great fear came on the whole assembly, and on all who heard these things. ¹²By the hands of the emissaries many signs and wonders were done among the people. They were all with one accord in Solomon's porch. ¹³None of the rest dared to join them; however, the people honored them. ¹⁴More believers were added to the Lord, multitudes of both men and women. ¹⁵They even carried out the sick into the streets and laid them on cots and mattresses, so that as Peter came by, at least his shadow might overshadow some of them. ¹⁶The multitude also came together from the cities around Jerusalem, bringing sick people and those who were tormented by unclean spirits; and they were all healed. ¹⁷But the high priest rose up, and all those who were with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees), and they were filled with jealousy ¹⁸and laid hands on the emissaries, then put them in public custody. ¹⁹But an angel of

the Lord opened the prison doors by night, and brought them out and said, ²⁰"Go stand and speak in the temple to the people all the words of this life." ²¹When they heard this, they entered into the temple about daybreak and taught. But the high priest and those who were with him came and called the council together, with all the senate of the children of Israel, and sent to the prison to have them brought. ²²But the officers who came didn't find them in the prison. They returned and reported, ²³"We found the prison shut and locked, and the guards standing before the doors, but when we opened them, we found no one inside!" ²⁴Now when the high priest, the captain of the temple, and the chief priests heard these words, they were very perplexed about them and what might become of this. ²⁵One came and told them, "Behold, the men whom you put in prison are in the temple, standing and teaching the people." ²⁶Then the captain went with the officers, and brought them without violence, for they were afraid that the people might stone them. ²⁷When they had brought them, they set them before the council. The high priest questioned them, ²⁸saying, "Didn't we strictly command you not to teach in this name? Behold, you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching, and intend to bring this man's blood on us." ²⁹But Peter and the emissaries answered, "We must obey God rather than men. ³⁰The God of our fathers raised up Yeshua, whom you killed, hanging him on a tree. ³¹God exalted him with his right hand to be a Prince and a Savior, to give repentance to Israel, and remission of sins. ³²We are his witnesses of these things; and so also is the Holy Spirit, whom God has given to those who obey him." ³³But they, when they heard this, were cut to the heart, and were determined to kill them. ³⁴But one stood up in the council, a Pharisee named Gamaliel, a teacher of the Torah, honored by all the people, and commanded to put the emissaries out for a little while. ³⁵He said to them, "You men of Israel, be careful concerning these men, what you are about to do. ³⁶For before these days Todah rose up, making himself out to be somebody; to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves. He was slain; and all, as many as obeyed him, were dispersed and came to nothing. ³⁷After this man, Judah of Galilee rose up in the days of the enrollment, and drew away some people after him. He also perished, and all, as many as obeyed him, were scattered abroad. ³⁸Now I tell you, withdraw from these men and leave them alone. For if this counsel or this work is of men, it will be overthrown. ³⁹But if it is of God, you will not be able to overthrow it, and you would be found even to be fighting against God!" ⁴⁰They agreed with him. Summoning the emissaries, they beat them and commanded them not to speak in the name of Yeshua, and let them go. ⁴¹They therefore departed from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were counted worthy to suffer dishonor for Yeshua's name. ⁴²Every day, in the temple and at home,

they never stopped teaching and proclaiming Yeshua, the Messiah.

6Now in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplying, a complaint arose from the Hellenists ^{xii} against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily service. ²The twelve summoned the multitude of the disciples and said, "It is not appropriate for us to forsake the word of God and serve tables. ³Therefore, select from among you, brothers, seven men of good report, full of the Holy Spirit and of wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business. ⁴But we will continue steadfastly in prayer and in the ministry of the word." ⁵These words pleased the whole multitude. They chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Spirit, Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolaus, a proselyte of Antioch, ⁶whom they set before the emissaries. When they had prayed, they laid their hands on them. ⁷The word of God increased and the number of the disciples greatly multiplied in Jerusalem. A great company of the priests were obedient to the faith. ⁸Stephen, full of faith and power, performed great wonders and signs among the people. ⁹But some of those who were of the synagogue called "The Libertines", and of the Cyrenians, of the Alexandrians, and of those of Cilicia and Asia arose, disputing with Stephen. ¹⁰They weren't able to withstand the wisdom and the Spirit by which he spoke. ¹¹Then they secretly induced men to say, "We have heard him speak blasphemous words against Moses and God." ¹²They stirred up the people, the elders, and the scribes, and came against him and seized him, then brought him in to the council, ¹³and set up false witnesses who said, "This man never stops speaking blasphemous words against this holy place and the Torah. ¹⁴For we have heard him say that this Yeshua of Nazareth will destroy this place, and will change the customs which Moses delivered to us." ¹⁵All who sat in the council, fastening their eyes on him, saw his face like it was the face of an angel.

7The high priest said, "Are these things so?" ²He said, "Brothers and fathers, listen. The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham when he was in Mesopotamia, before he lived in Haran, ³and said to him, 'Get out of your land and away from your relatives, and come into a land which I will show you.' ⁴Then he came out of the land of the Kasdim and lived in Haran. From there, when his father was dead, God moved him into this land where you are now living. ⁵He gave him no inheritance in it, no, not so much as to set his foot on. He promised that he would give it to him for a possession, and to his offspring after him, when he still had no child. ⁶God spoke in this way: that his offspring would live as aliens in a strange land,

and that they would be enslaved and mistreated for four hundred years. ⁷'I will judge the nation to which they will be in bondage,' said God, 'and after that they will come out and serve me in this place.' ⁸He gave him the covenant of circumcision. So Abraham became the father of Isaac, and circumcised him the eighth day. Isaac became the father of Jacob, and Jacob became the father of the twelve patriarchs. ⁹"The patriarchs, moved with jealousy against Joseph, sold him into Egypt. God was with him ¹⁰and delivered him out of all his afflictions, and gave him favor and wisdom before Pharaoh, king of Egypt. He made him governor over Egypt and all his house. ¹¹Now a famine came over all the land of Egypt and Canaan, and great affliction. Our fathers found no food. ¹²But when Jacob heard that there was grain in Egypt, he sent out our fathers the first time. ¹³On the second time Joseph was made known to his brothers, and Joseph's family was revealed to Pharaoh. ¹⁴Joseph sent and summoned Jacob his father and all his relatives, seventy-five souls. ¹⁵Jacob went down into Egypt and he died, himself and our fathers; ¹⁶and they were brought back to Shechem and laid in the tomb that Abraham bought for a price in silver from the children of Hamor of Shechem. ¹⁷"But as the time of the promise came close which God had sworn to Abraham, the people grew and multiplied in Egypt, ¹⁸until there arose a different king who didn't know Joseph. ¹⁹The same took advantage of our race and mistreated our fathers, and forced them to abandon their babies, so that they wouldn't stay alive. ²⁰At that time Moses was born, and was exceedingly handsome to God. He was nourished three months in his father's house. ²¹When he was abandoned, Pharaoh's daughter took him up and reared him as her own son. ²²Moses was instructed in all the wisdom of the Egyptians. He was mighty in his words and works. ²³But when he was forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brothers, ^{xiii} the children of Israel. ²⁴Seeing one of them suffer wrong, he defended him and avenged him who was oppressed, striking the Egyptian. ²⁵He supposed that his brothers understood that God, by his hand, was giving them deliverance; but they didn't understand. ²⁶"The day following, he appeared to them as they fought, and urged them to be at peace again, saying, 'Sirs, you are brothers. Why do you wrong one another?' ²⁷But he who did his neighbor wrong pushed him away, saying, 'Who made you a ruler and a judge over us?' ²⁸Do you want to kill me as you killed the Egyptian yesterday?' ²⁹Moses fled at this saying, and became a stranger in the land of Midian, where he became the father of two sons. ³⁰"When forty years were fulfilled, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in the wilderness of Mount Sinai, in a flame of fire in a bush. ³¹When Moses saw it, he wondered at the sight. As he came close to see, the voice of the Lord came to him,

^{xii}The Hellenists used Greek language and culture, even though they were also of Hebrew descent.

^{xiii}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

³²‘I am the God of your fathers: the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.’ Moses trembled and dared not look. ³³The Lord said to him, ‘Take off your sandals, for the place where you stand is holy ground. ³⁴I have surely seen the affliction of my people who are in Egypt, and have heard their groaning. I have come down to deliver them. Now come, I will send you into Egypt.’ ³⁵“This Moses whom they refused, saying, ‘Who made you a ruler and a judge?’—God has sent him as both a ruler and a deliverer by the hand of the angel who appeared to him in the bush. ³⁶This man led them out, having worked wonders and signs in Egypt, in the Sea of Suf, and in the wilderness for forty years. ³⁷This is that Moses who said to the children of Israel, ‘The Lord our God will raise up a prophet for you from among your brothers, like me.’ ^{xiv} ³⁸This is he who was in the assembly in the wilderness with the angel that spoke to him on Mount Sinai, and with our fathers, who received living revelations to give to us, ³⁹to whom our fathers wouldn’t be obedient, but rejected him and turned back in their hearts to Egypt, ⁴⁰saying to Aaron, ‘Make us gods that will go before us, for as for this Moses who led us out of the land of Egypt, we don’t know what has become of him.’ ⁴¹They made a calf in those days, and brought a sacrifice to the idol, and rejoiced in the works of their hands. ⁴²But God turned away and gave them up to serve the army of the sky, ^{xv} as it is written in the book of the prophets, ‘Did you offer to me slain animals and sacrifices forty years in the wilderness, O house of Israel? ⁴³You took up the tabernacle of Moloch, the star of your god Rephan, the figures which you made to worship, so I will carry you away beyond Babylon.’ ⁴⁴“Our fathers had the tabernacle of the testimony in the wilderness, even as he who spoke to Moses commanded him to make it according to the pattern that he had seen; ⁴⁵which also our fathers, in their turn, brought in with Joshua when they entered into the possession of the nations whom God drove out before the face of our fathers to the days of David, ⁴⁶who found favor in the sight of God, and asked to find a habitation for the God of Jacob. ⁴⁷But Solomon built him a house. ⁴⁸However, the Most High doesn’t dwell in temples made with hands, as the prophet says, ⁴⁹‘heaven is my throne, and the earth a footstool for my feet. What kind of house will you build me?’ says the Lord. ‘Or what is the place of my rest? ⁵⁰Didn’t my hand make all these things?’ ⁵¹“You stiff-necked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Spirit! As your fathers did, so you do. ⁵²Which of the prophets didn’t your fathers persecute? They killed those who foretold the coming of the Righteous One, of whom you have now become betrayers and murderers. ⁵³You received the Torah as it was ordained by angels, and didn’t keep it!” ⁵⁴Now when they

heard these things, they were cut to the heart, and they gnashed at him with their teeth. ⁵⁵But he, being full of the Holy Spirit, looked up steadfastly into heaven and saw the glory of God, and Yeshua standing on the right hand of God, ⁵⁶and said, “Behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God!” ⁵⁷But they cried out with a loud voice and stopped their ears, then rushed at him with one accord. ⁵⁸They threw him out of the city and stoned him. The witnesses placed their garments at the feet of a young man named Saul. ⁵⁹They stoned Stephen as he called out, saying, “Lord Yeshua, receive my spirit!” ⁶⁰He kneeled down and cried with a loud voice, “Lord, don’t hold this sin against them!” When he had said this, he fell asleep.

⁸Saul was consenting to his death. A great persecution arose against the assembly which was in Jerusalem in that day. They were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judea and Samaria, except for the emissaries. ²Devout men buried Stephen and lamented greatly over him. ³But Saul ravaged the assembly, entering into every house and dragged both men and women off to prison. ⁴Therefore those who were scattered abroad went around proclaiming the word. ⁵Philip went down to the city of Samaria and proclaimed to them the Messiah. ⁶The multitudes listened with one accord to the things that were spoken by Philip when they heard and saw the signs which he did. ⁷For unclean spirits came out of many of those who had them. They came out, crying with a loud voice. Many who had been paralyzed and lame were healed. ⁸There was great joy in that city. ⁹But there was a certain man, Simon by name, who used to practice sorcery in the city and amazed the people of Samaria, making himself out to be some great one, ¹⁰to whom they all listened, from the least to the greatest, saying, “This man is that great power of God.” ¹¹They listened to him because for a long time he had amazed them with his sorceries. ¹²But when they believed Philip proclaiming good news concerning God’s Kingdom and the name of Yeshua the Messiah, they were immersed, both men and women. ¹³Simon himself also believed. Being immersed, he continued with Philip. Seeing signs and great miracles occurring, he was amazed. ¹⁴Now when the emissaries who were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent Peter and Yochanan to them, ¹⁵who, when they had come down, prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Spirit; ¹⁶for as yet he had fallen on none of them. They had only been immersed in the name of Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁷Then they laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit. ¹⁸Now when Simon saw that the Holy Spirit was given through the laying on of the emissaries’ hands, he offered them money, ¹⁹saying, “Give me also this power, that whomever I lay my hands on may receive the Holy Spirit.” ²⁰But Peter said to him, “May your silver perish with you,

^{xiv}TR adds “You shall listen to him.”

^{xv}This idiom could also be translated “host of heaven”, or “angelic beings”, or “heavenly bodies.”

because you thought you could obtain the gift of God with money! ²¹You have neither part nor lot in this matter, for your heart isn't right before God. ²²Repent therefore of this, your wickedness, and ask God if perhaps the thought of your heart may be forgiven you. ²³For I see that you are in the poison of bitterness and in the bondage of iniquity." ²⁴Simon answered, "Pray for me to the Lord, that none of the things which you have spoken happen to me." ²⁵They therefore, when they had testified and spoken the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem, and preached the Good News to many villages of the Samaritans. ²⁶Then an angel of the Lord spoke to Philip, saying, "Arise, and go toward the south to the way that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza. This is a desert." ²⁷He arose and went; and behold, there was a man of Ethiopia, a eunuch of great authority under Candace, queen of the Ethiopians, who was over all her treasure, who had come to Jerusalem to worship. ²⁸He was returning and sitting in his chariot, and was reading the prophet Isaiah. ²⁹The Spirit said to Philip, "Go near, and join yourself to this chariot." ³⁰Philip ran to him, and heard him reading Isaiah the prophet, and said, "Do you understand what you are reading?" ³¹He said, "How can I, unless someone explains it to me?" He begged Philip to come up and sit with him. ³²Now the passage of the Scripture which he was reading was this, "He was led as a sheep to the slaughter. As a lamb before his shearer is silent, so he doesn't open his mouth. ³³In his humiliation, his judgment was taken away. Who will declare His generation? For his life is taken from the earth." ³⁴The eunuch answered Philip, "Who is the prophet talking about? About himself, or about someone else?" ³⁵Philip opened his mouth, and beginning from this Scripture, preached to him about Yeshua. ³⁶As they went on the way, they came to some water; and the eunuch said, "Behold, here is water. What is keeping me from being immersed?" ³⁷^{xvi} ³⁸He commanded the chariot to stand still, and they both went down into the water, both Philip and the eunuch, and he immersed him. ³⁹When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord caught Philip away, and the eunuch didn't see him any more, for he went on his way rejoicing. ⁴⁰But Philip was found at Azotus. Passing through, he preached the Good News to all the cities until he came to Caesarea.

⁹But Saul, still breathing threats and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest ²and asked for letters from him to the synagogues of Damascus, that if he found any who were of the Way, whether men or women, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem. ³As he traveled, he got close to Damascus, and suddenly a light from the sky shone around him. ⁴He fell on the earth, and heard a voice saying to him, "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?" ⁵He said, "Who are you, Lord?"

^{xvi}TR adds

The Lord said, "I am Yeshua, whom you are persecuting." ^{xvii} ⁶But ^{xviii} rise up and enter into the city, then you will be told what you must do." ⁷The men who traveled with him stood speechless, hearing the sound, but seeing no one. ⁸Saul arose from the ground, and when his eyes were opened, he saw no one. They led him by the hand and brought him into Damascus. ⁹He was without sight for three days, and neither ate nor drank. ¹⁰Now there was a certain disciple at Damascus named Hananiah. The Lord said to him in a vision, "Hananiah!" He said, "Behold, it's me, Lord." ¹¹The Lord said to him, "Arise and go to the street which is called Straight, and inquire in the house of Judah ^{xix} for one named Saul, a man of Tarsus. For behold, he is praying, ¹²and in a vision he has seen a man named Hananiah coming in and laying his hands on him, that he might receive his sight." ¹³But Hananiah answered, "Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much evil he did to your holy ones at Jerusalem. ¹⁴Here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all who call on your name." ¹⁵But the Lord said to him, "Go your way, for he is my chosen vessel to bear my name before the nations and kings, and the children of Israel. ¹⁶For I will show him how many things he must suffer for my name's sake." ¹⁷Hananiah departed and entered into the house. Laying his hands on him, he said, "Brother Saul, the Lord, who appeared to you on the road by which you came, has sent me that you may receive your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit." ¹⁸Immediately something like scales fell from his eyes, and he received his sight. He arose and was immersed. ¹⁹He took food and was strengthened. Saul stayed several days with the disciples who were at Damascus. ²⁰Immediately in the synagogues he proclaimed the Messiah, that he is the Son of God. ²¹All who heard him were amazed, and said, "Isn't this he who in Jerusalem made havoc of those who called on this name? And he had come here intending to bring them bound before the chief priests!" ²²But Saul increased more in strength, and confounded the Jews who lived at Damascus, proving that this is the Messiah. ²³When many days were fulfilled, the Jews conspired together to kill him, ²⁴but their plot became known to Saul. They watched the gates both day and night that they might kill him, ²⁵but his disciples took him by night and let him down through the wall, lowering him in a basket. ²⁶When Saul had come to Jerusalem, he tried to join himself to the disciples; but they were all afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple. ²⁷But Barnabas took him and brought him to the emissaries, and declared to them how he had seen the Lord on the way, and that he had spoken to him, and how at Damascus he had preached boldly in the name of Yeshua. ²⁸He was with

^{xvii}TR adds "It's hard for you to kick against the cattle prods."

^{xviii}TR omits "But"

^{xix}or, Judah

them entering into ^{xx} Jerusalem, ²⁹proclaiming boldly in the name of the Lord Yeshua. ^{xxi} He spoke and disputed against the Hellenists, ^{xxii} but they were seeking to kill him. ³⁰When the brothers ^{xxiii} knew it, they brought him down to Caesarea and sent him off to Tarsus. ³¹So the assemblies throughout all Judea, Galilee, and Samaria had peace and were built up. They were multiplied, walking in the fear of the Lord and in the comfort of the Holy Spirit. ³²As Peter went throughout all those parts, he came down also to the holy ones who lived at Lydda. ³³There he found a certain man named Aeneas, who had been bedridden for eight years because he was paralyzed. ³⁴Peter said to him, "Aeneas, Yeshua the Messiah heals you. Get up and make your bed!" Immediately he arose. ³⁵All who lived at Lydda and in Sharon saw him, and they turned to the Lord. ³⁶Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named Tavita, which when translated means Dorcas. ^{xxiv} This woman was full of good works and acts of mercy which she did. ³⁷In those days, she became sick and died. When they had washed her, they laid her in an upper room. ³⁸As Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples, hearing that Peter was there, sent two men ^{xxv} to him, imploring him not to delay in coming to them. ³⁹Peter got up and went with them. When he had come, they brought him into the upper room. All the widows stood by him weeping, and showing the tunics and other garments which Dorcas had made while she was with them. ⁴⁰Peter sent them all out, and knelt down and prayed. Turning to the body, he said, "Tavita, get up!" She opened her eyes, and when she saw Peter, she sat up. ⁴¹He gave her his hand and raised her up. Calling the holy ones and widows, he presented her alive. ⁴²This became known throughout all Joppa, and many believed in the Lord. ⁴³He stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon.

¹⁰Now there was a certain man in Caesarea, Cornelius by name, a centurion of what was called the Italian Regiment, ²a devout man, and one who feared God with all his house, who gave gifts for the needy generously to the people, and always prayed to God. ³At about the ninth hour of the day, ^{xxvi} he clearly saw in a vision an angel of God coming to him and saying to him, "Cornelius!" ⁴He, fastening his eyes on him and being frightened, said, "What is it, Lord?" He said to him, "Your prayers and your gifts to the needy have gone up for a memorial before God. ⁵Now send men to Joppa, and get Simon, who is

also called Peter. ⁶He is staying with a tanner named Simon, whose house is by the seaside. ^{xxvii} ⁷When the angel who spoke to him had departed, Cornelius called two of his household servants and a devout soldier of those who waited on him continually. ⁸Having explained everything to them, he sent them to Joppa. ⁹Now on the next day as they were on their journey and got close to the city, Peter went up on the housetop to pray at about noon. ¹⁰He became hungry and desired to eat, but while they were preparing, he fell into a trance. ¹¹He saw heaven opened and a certain container descending to him, like a great sheet let down by four corners on the earth, ¹²in which were all kinds of four-footed animals of the earth, wild animals, reptiles, and birds of the sky. ¹³A voice came to him, "Rise, Peter, kill and eat!" ¹⁴But Peter said, "Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten anything that is common or unclean." ¹⁵A voice came to him again the second time, "What God has cleansed, you must not call unclean." ¹⁶This was done three times, and immediately the thing was received up into heaven. ¹⁷Now while Peter was very perplexed in himself what the vision which he had seen might mean, behold, the men who were sent by Cornelius, having made inquiry for Simon's house, stood before the gate, ¹⁸and called and asked whether Simon, who was also called Peter, was lodging there. ¹⁹While Peter was pondering the vision, the Spirit said to him, "Behold, three ^{xxviii} men seek you. ²⁰But arise, get down, and go with them, doubting nothing; for I have sent them." ²¹Peter went down to the men, and said, "Behold, I am he whom you seek. Why have you come?" ²²They said, "Cornelius, a centurion, a righteous man and one who fears God, and well spoken of by all the Jewish nation, was directed by a holy angel to invite you to his house, and to listen to what you say." ²³So he called them in and provided a place to stay. On the next day Peter arose and went out with them, and some of the brothers from Joppa accompanied him. ²⁴On the next day they entered into Caesarea. Cornelius was waiting for them, having called together his relatives and his near friends. ²⁵When Peter entered, Cornelius met him, fell down at his feet, and worshiped him. ²⁶But Peter raised him up, saying, "Stand up! I myself am also a man." ²⁷As he talked with him, he went in and found many gathered together. ²⁸He said to them, "You yourselves know how it is an unlawful thing for a man who is a Jew to join himself or come to one of another nation, but God has shown me that I shouldn't call any man unholy or unclean. ²⁹Therefore I also came without complaint when I was sent for. I ask therefore, why did you send for me?" ³⁰Cornelius said, "Four days ago, I was fasting until this hour; and at the ninth hour, ^{xxix} I prayed

^{xx}TR and NU add "and going out"

^{xxi}TR and NU omit "Yeshua" and reverse the order of verses 28 & 29.

^{xxii}The Hellenists were Hebrews who used Greek language and culture.

^{xxiii}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{xxiv}"Dorcas" is Greek for "Gazelle."

^{xxv}Reading from NU, TR; MT omits "two men"

^{xxvi}3:00 p.m.

^{xxvii}TR adds "This one will tell you what it is necessary for you to do."

^{xxviii}Reading from TR and NU. MT omits "three"

^{xxix}3:00 p.m.

in my house, and behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing ³¹and said, ‘Cornelius, your prayer is heard, and your gifts to the needy are remembered in the sight of God. ³²Send therefore to Joppa and summon Simon, who is also called Peter. He is staying in the house of a tanner named Simon, by the seaside. When he comes, he will speak to you.’ ³³Therefore I sent to you at once, and it was good of you to come. Now therefore we are all here present in the sight of God to hear all things that have been commanded you by God.” ³⁴Peter opened his mouth and said, “Truly I perceive that God doesn’t show favoritism; ³⁵but in every nation he who fears him and works righteousness is acceptable to him. ³⁶The word which he sent to the children of Israel, proclaiming good news of peace by Yeshua the Messiah—he is Lord of all— ³⁷you yourselves know what happened, which was proclaimed throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee, after the immersion which Yochanan preached; ³⁸how God anointed Yeshua of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, who went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him. ³⁹We are witnesses of everything he did both in the countryside of Judea and in Jerusalem; whom they also ^{xxx} killed, hanging him on a tree. ⁴⁰God raised him up the third day and gave him to be revealed, ⁴¹not to all the people, but to witnesses who were chosen before by God, to us, who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead. ⁴²He commanded us to proclaim to the people and to testify that this is he who is appointed by God as the Judge of the living and the dead. ⁴³All the prophets testify about him, that through his name everyone who believes in him will receive remission of sins.” ⁴⁴While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit fell on all those who heard the word. ⁴⁵They of the circumcision who believed were amazed, as many as came with Peter, because the gift of the Holy Spirit was also poured out on the Gentiles. ⁴⁶For they heard them speaking in other languages and magnifying God. Then Peter answered, ⁴⁷“Can anyone forbid these people from being immersed with water? They have received the Holy Spirit just like us.” ⁴⁸He commanded them to be immersed in the name of Yeshua the Messiah. Then they asked him to stay some days.

11 Now the emissaries and the brothers ^{xxxi} who were in Judea heard that the Gentiles had also received the word of God. ²When Peter had come up to Jerusalem, those who were of the circumcision contended with him, ³saying, “You went in to uncircumcised men and ate with them!” ⁴But Peter began, and explained to them in order, saying, ⁵“I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision: a certain container descending, like it was a great sheet let down from heaven by four corners. It

came as far as me. ⁶When I had looked intently at it, I considered, and saw the four-footed animals of the earth, wild animals, creeping things, and birds of the sky. ⁷I also heard a voice saying to me, ‘Rise, Peter, kill and eat!’ ⁸But I said, ‘Not so, Lord, for nothing unholy or unclean has ever entered into my mouth.’ ⁹But a voice answered me the second time out of heaven, ‘What God has cleansed, don’t you call unclean.’ ¹⁰This was done three times, and all were drawn up again into heaven. ¹¹Behold, immediately three men stood before the house where I was, having been sent from Caesarea to me. ¹²The Spirit told me to go with them without discriminating. These six brothers also accompanied me, and we entered into the man’s house. ¹³He told us how he had seen the angel standing in his house and saying to him, ‘Send to Joppa and get Simon, who is called Peter, ¹⁴who will speak to you words by which you will be saved, you and all your house.’ ¹⁵As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell on them, even as on us at the beginning. ¹⁶I remembered the word of the Lord, how he said, ‘Yochanan indeed immersed in water, but you will be immersed in the Holy Spirit.’ ¹⁷If then God gave to them the same gift as us when we believed in the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, who was I, that I could withstand God?” ¹⁸When they heard these things, they held their peace and glorified God, saying, “Then God has also granted to the Gentiles repentance to life!” ¹⁹They therefore who were scattered abroad by the oppression that arose about Stephen traveled as far as Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, speaking the word to no one except to Jews only. ²⁰But there were some of them, men of Cyprus and Cyrene, who, when they had come to Antioch, spoke to the Hellenists, ^{xxxii} proclaiming the Lord Yeshua. ²¹The hand of the Lord was with them, and a great number believed and turned to the Lord. ²²The report concerning them came to the ears of the assembly which was in Jerusalem. They sent out Barnabas to go as far as Antioch, ²³who, when he had come, and had seen the grace of God, was glad. He exhorted them all, that with purpose of heart they should remain near to the Lord. ²⁴For he was a good man, and full of the Holy Spirit and of faith, and many people were added to the Lord. ²⁵Barnabas went out to Tarsus to look for Saul. ²⁶When he had found him, he brought him to Antioch. For a whole year they were gathered together with the assembly, and taught many people. The disciples were first called Messianic in Antioch. ²⁷Now in these days, prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch. ²⁸One of them named Agabus stood up and indicated by the Spirit that there should be a great famine all over the world, which also happened in the days of Claudius. ²⁹As any of the disciples had plenty, each determined to send relief to the brothers who lived in Judea; ³⁰which they also did, sending it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

^{xxx}TR omits “also”

^{xxxi}The word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

^{xxxii}A Hellenist is someone who keeps Greek customs and culture.

¹²Now about that time, King Herod stretched out his hands to oppress some of the assembly. ²He killed Jacob, the brother of Yochanan, with the sword. ³When he saw that it pleased the Judeans, he proceeded to seize Peter also. This was during the days of unleavened bread. ⁴When he had arrested him, he put him in prison and delivered him to four squads of four soldiers each to guard him, intending to bring him out to the people after the Passover. ⁵Peter therefore was kept in the prison, but constant prayer was made by the assembly to God for him. ⁶The same night when Herod was about to bring him out, Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains. Guards in front of the door kept the prison. ⁷And behold, an angel of the Lord stood by him, and a light shone in the cell. He struck Peter on the side and woke him up, saying, "Stand up quickly!" His chains fell off his hands. ⁸The angel said to him, "Get dressed and put on your sandals." He did so. He said to him, "Put on your cloak and follow me." ⁹And he went out and followed him. He didn't know that what was being done by the angel was real, but thought he saw a vision. ¹⁰When they were past the first and the second guard, they came to the iron gate that leads into the city, which opened to them by itself. They went out and went down one street, and immediately the angel departed from him. ¹¹When Peter had come to himself, he said, "Now I truly know that the Lord has sent out his angel and delivered me out of the hand of Herod, and from everything the Jewish people were expecting." ¹²Thinking about that, he came to the house of Miriam, the mother of Yochanan who was called Mark, where many were gathered together and were praying. ¹³When Peter knocked at the door of the gate, a servant girl named Rhoda came to answer. ¹⁴When she recognized Peter's voice, she didn't open the gate for joy, but ran in and reported that Peter was standing in front of the gate. ¹⁵They said to her, "You are crazy!" But she insisted that it was so. They said, "It is his angel." ¹⁶But Peter continued knocking. When they had opened, they saw him and were amazed. ¹⁷But he, beckoning to them with his hand to be silent, declared to them how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. He said, "Tell these things to Jacob and to the brothers." Then he departed and went to another place. ¹⁸Now as soon as it was day, there was no small stir among the soldiers about what had become of Peter. ¹⁹When Herod had sought for him and didn't find him, he examined the guards, then commanded that they should be put to death. He went down from Judea to Caesarea, and stayed there. ²⁰Now Herod was very angry with the people of Tyre and Sidon. They came with one accord to him and, having made Blastus, the king's personal aide, their friend, they asked for peace, because their country depended on the king's country for food. ²¹On an appointed day, Herod dressed himself in royal clothing, sat on the throne, and gave a speech to

them. ²²The people shouted, "The voice of a god, and not of a man!" ²³Immediately an angel of the Lord struck him, because he didn't give God the glory. Then he was eaten by worms and died. ²⁴But the word of God grew and multiplied. ²⁵Barnabas and Saul returned to ^{xxxiii} Jerusalem when they had fulfilled their service, also taking with them Yochanan who was called Mark.

¹³Now in the assembly that was at Antioch there were some prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon who was called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen the foster brother of Herod the tetrarch, and Saul. ²As they served the Lord and fasted, the Holy Spirit said, "Separate Barnabas and Saul for me, for the work to which I have called them." ³Then, when they had fasted and prayed and laid their hands on them, they sent them away. ⁴So, being sent out by the Holy Spirit, they went down to Seleucia. From there they sailed to Cyprus. ⁵When they were at Salamis, they proclaimed God's word in the Jewish synagogues. They also had Yochanan as their attendant. ⁶When they had gone through the island to Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew whose name was Bar-Yeshua, ⁷who was with the proconsul, Sergius Paulus, a man of understanding. This man summoned Barnabas and Saul, and sought to hear the word of God. ⁸But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his name by interpretation) withstood them, seeking to turn the proconsul away from the faith. ⁹But Saul, who is also called Paul, filled with the Holy Spirit, fastened his eyes on him ¹⁰and said, "You son of the devil, full of all deceit and all cunning, you enemy of all righteousness, will you not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord? ¹¹Now, behold, the hand of the Lord is on you, and you will be blind, not seeing the sun for a season!" Immediately a mist and darkness fell on him. He went around seeking someone to lead him by the hand. ¹²Then the proconsul, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the teaching of the Lord. ¹³Now Paul and his company set sail from Paphos and came to Perga in Pamphylia. Yochanan departed from them and returned to Jerusalem. ¹⁴But they, passing on from Perga, came to Antioch of Pisidia. They went into the synagogue on the Sabbath day and sat down. ¹⁵After the reading of the Torah and the Prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent to them, saying, "Brothers, if you have any word of exhortation for the people, speak." ¹⁶Paul stood up, and gesturing with his hand said, "Men of Israel, and you who fear God, listen. ¹⁷The God of this people ^{xxxiv} chose our fathers, and exalted the people when they stayed as aliens in the land of Egypt, and with an uplifted arm, he led them out of it. ¹⁸For a period of about forty years he put up with them in the wilderness. ¹⁹When he had destroyed seven nations in the land of Canaan, he gave them their

^{xxxiii}TR reads "from" instead of "to"

^{xxxiv}TR, NU add "Israel"

land for an inheritance for about four hundred fifty years. ²⁰After these things, he gave them judges until Samuel the prophet. ²¹Afterward they asked for a king, and God gave to them Saul the son of Kish, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, for forty years. ²²When he had removed him, he raised up David to be their king, to whom he also testified, 'I have found David the son of Jesse, a man after my heart, who will do all my will.' ²³From this man's offspring, God has brought salvation ^{xxxv} to Israel according to his promise, ²⁴before his coming, when Yochanan had first preached the immersion of repentance to Israel. ^{xxxvi} ²⁵As Yochanan was fulfilling his course, he said, 'What do you suppose that I am? I am not he. But behold, one comes after me, the sandals of whose feet I am not worthy to untie.' ²⁶"Brothers, children of the stock of Abraham, and those among you who fear God, the word of this salvation is sent out to you. ²⁷For those who dwell in Jerusalem, and their rulers, because they didn't know him, nor the voices of the prophets which are read every Sabbath, fulfilled them by condemning him. ²⁸Though they found no cause for death, they still asked Pilate to have him killed. ²⁹When they had fulfilled all things that were written about him, they took him down from the tree and laid him in a tomb. ³⁰But God raised him from the dead, ³¹and he was seen for many days by those who came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who are his witnesses to the people. ³²We bring you good news of the promise made to the fathers, ³³that God has fulfilled this to us, their children, in that he raised up Yeshua. As it is also written in the second psalm, 'You are my Son. Today I have become your father.' ³⁴"Concerning that he raised him up from the dead, now no more to return to corruption, he has spoken thus: 'I will give you the holy and sure blessings of David.' ³⁵Therefore he says also in another psalm, 'You will not allow your Holy One to see decay.' ³⁶For David, after he had in his own generation served the counsel of God, fell asleep, was laid with his fathers, and saw decay. ³⁷But he whom God raised up saw no decay. ³⁸Be it known to you therefore, brothers, ^{xxxvii} that through this man is proclaimed to you remission of sins; ³⁹and by him everyone who believes is justified from all things, from which you could not be justified by the Torah of Moses. ⁴⁰Beware therefore, lest that come on you which is spoken in the Prophets: ⁴¹'Behold, you scoffers! Wonder and perish, for I work a work in your days, a work which you will in no way believe, if one declares it to you.' ⁴²So when the Jews went out of the synagogue, the Gentiles begged that these words might be preached to them the next Sabbath. ⁴³Now when the synagogue broke up, many of the Jews and of the devout proselytes followed Paul and

Barnabas; who, speaking to them, urged them to continue in the grace of God. ⁴⁴The next Sabbath, almost the whole city was gathered together to hear the word of God. ⁴⁵But when the Jews saw the multitudes, they were filled with jealousy, and contradicted the things which were spoken by Paul, and blasphemed. ⁴⁶Paul and Barnabas spoke out boldly, and said, "It was necessary that God's word should be spoken to you first. Since indeed you thrust it from yourselves, and judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life, behold, we turn to the Gentiles. ⁴⁷For so has the Lord commanded us, saying, 'I have set you as a light for the Gentiles, that you should bring salvation to the uttermost parts of the earth.'" ⁴⁸As the Gentiles heard this, they were glad and glorified the word of God. As many as were appointed to eternal life believed. ⁴⁹The Lord's word was spread abroad throughout all the region. ⁵⁰But the Jews stirred up the devout and prominent women and the chief men of the city, and stirred up a persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and threw them out of their borders. ⁵¹But they shook off the dust of their feet against them, and came to Iconium. ⁵²The disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Spirit.

¹⁴In Iconium, they entered together into the Jewish synagogue, and so spoke that a great multitude both of Jews and of Greeks believed. ²But the disbelieving ^{xxxviii} Jews stirred up and embittered the souls of the Gentiles against the brothers. ³Therefore they stayed there a long time, speaking boldly in the Lord, who testified to the word of his grace, granting signs and wonders to be done by their hands. ⁴But the multitude of the city was divided. Part sided with the Jews and part with the emissaries. ⁵When some of both the Gentiles and the Jews, with their rulers, made a violent attempt to mistreat and stone them, ⁶they became aware of it and fled to the cities of Lycaonia, Lystra, Derbe, and the surrounding region. ⁷There they preached the Good News. ⁸At Lystra a certain man sat, impotent in his feet, a cripple from his mother's womb, who never had walked. ⁹He was listening to Paul speaking, who, fastening eyes on him and seeing that he had faith to be made whole, ¹⁰said with a loud voice, "Stand upright on your feet!" He leaped up and walked. ¹¹When the multitude saw what Paul had done, they lifted up their voice, saying in the language of Lycaonia, "The gods have come down to us in the likeness of men!" ¹²They called Barnabas "Jupiter", and Paul "Mercury", because he was the chief speaker. ¹³The priest of Jupiter, whose temple was in front of their city, brought oxen and garlands to the gates, and would have made a sacrifice along with the multitudes. ¹⁴But when the emissaries, Barnabas and Paul, heard of it, they tore their clothes and sprang into the multitude, crying out, ¹⁵"Men, why are you doing these things? We also are men of the same nature as you, and bring you

^{xxxv}TR, NU read "a Savior, Yeshua" instead of "salvation"

^{xxxvi}TR, NU read "to all the people of Israel" instead of "to Israel"

^{xxxvii}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{xxxviii}or, disobedient

good news, that you should turn from these vain things to the living God, who made the sky, the earth, the sea, and all that is in them; ¹⁶who in the generations gone by allowed all the nations to walk in their own ways. ¹⁷Yet he didn't leave himself without witness, in that he did good and gave you ^{xxxix} rains from the sky and fruitful seasons, filling our hearts with food and gladness." ¹⁸Even saying these things, they hardly stopped the multitudes from making a sacrifice to them. ¹⁹But some Jews from Antioch and Iconium came there, and having persuaded the multitudes, they stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing that he was dead. ²⁰But as the disciples stood around him, he rose up, and entered into the city. On the next day he went out with Barnabas to Derbe. ²¹When they had preached the Good News to that city and had made many disciples, they returned to Lystra, Iconium, and Antioch, ²²strengthening the souls of the disciples, exhorting them to continue in the faith, and that through many afflictions we must enter into God's Kingdom. ²³When they had appointed elders for them in every assembly, and had prayed with fasting, they commended them to the Lord on whom they had believed. ²⁴They passed through Pisidia and came to Pamphylia. ²⁵When they had spoken the word in Perga, they went down to Attalia. ²⁶From there they sailed to Antioch, from where they had been committed to the grace of God for the work which they had fulfilled. ²⁷When they had arrived and had gathered the assembly together, they reported all the things that God had done with them, and that he had opened a door of faith to the nations. ²⁸They stayed there with the disciples for a long time.

¹⁵Some men came down from Judea and taught the brothers, ^{xi} "Unless you are circumcised after the custom of Moses, you can't be saved." ²Therefore when Paul and Barnabas had no small discord and discussion with them, they appointed Paul, Barnabas, and some others of them to go up to Jerusalem to the emissaries and elders about this question. ³They, being sent on their way by the assembly, passed through both Phoenicia and Samaria, declaring the conversion of the Gentiles. They caused great joy to all the brothers. ⁴When they had come to Jerusalem, they were received by the assembly and the emissaries and the elders, and they reported everything that God had done with them. ⁵But some of the sect of the Pharisees who believed rose up, saying, "It is necessary to circumcise them, and to command them to keep the Torah of Moses." ⁶The emissaries and the elders were gathered together to see about this matter. ⁷When there had been much discussion, Peter rose up and said to them, "Brothers, you know that a good while ago God made a choice

among you that by my mouth the nations should hear the word of the Good News and believe. ⁸God, who knows the heart, testified about them, giving them the Holy Spirit, just like he did to us. ⁹He made no distinction between us and them, cleansing their hearts by faith. ¹⁰Now therefore why do you tempt God, that you should put a yoke on the neck of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we were able to bear? ¹¹But we believe that we are saved through the grace of the Lord Yeshua, ^{xli} just as they are." ¹²All the multitude kept silence, and they listened to Barnabas and Paul reporting what signs and wonders God had done among the nations through them. ¹³After they were silent, Jacob answered, "Brothers, listen to me. ¹⁴Simeon has reported how God first visited the nations to take out of them a people for his name. ¹⁵This agrees with the words of the prophets. As it is written, ¹⁶'After these things I will return. I will again build the tabernacle of David, which has fallen. I will again build its ruins. I will set it up ¹⁷that the rest of men may seek after the Lord; all the Gentiles who are called by my name, says the Lord, who does all these things.' ¹⁸'All of God's works are known to him from eternity. ¹⁹Therefore my judgment is that we don't trouble those from among the Gentiles who turn to God, ²⁰but that we write to them that they abstain from the pollution of idols, from sexual immorality, from what is strangled, and from blood. ²¹For Moses from generations of old has in every city those who proclaim him, being read in the synagogues every Sabbath.'" ²²Then it seemed good to the emissaries and the elders, with the whole assembly, to choose men out of their company, and send them to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas: Judah called Barsabbas, and Silas, chief men among the brothers. ^{xlii} ²³They wrote these things by their hand: "The emissaries, the elders, and the brothers, to the brothers who are of the Gentiles in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia: greetings. ²⁴Because we have heard that some who went out from us have troubled you with words, unsettling your souls, saying, 'You must be circumcised and keep the Torah,' to whom we gave no commandment; ²⁵it seemed good to us, having come to one accord, to choose out men and send them to you with our beloved Barnabas and Paul, ²⁶men who have risked their lives for the name of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ²⁷We have sent therefore Judah and Silas, who themselves will also tell you the same things by word of mouth. ²⁸For it seemed good to the Holy Spirit, and to us, to lay no greater burden on you than these necessary things: ²⁹that you abstain from things sacrificed to idols, from blood, from things strangled, and from sexual immorality, from which if you keep yourselves, it will be well with you. Farewell." ³⁰So, when they were sent off, they came to Antioch. Having gathered the multitude together,

^{xxxix}TR reads "us" instead of "you"

^{xi}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{xli}TR adds "Messiah"

^{xlii}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

they delivered the letter. ³¹When they had read it, they rejoiced over the encouragement. ³²Judah and Silas, also being prophets themselves, encouraged the brothers with many words and strengthened them. ³³After they had spent some time there, they were dismissed in peace from the brothers to the emissaries. ³⁴^{xliii} ³⁵But Paul and Barnabas stayed in Antioch, teaching and proclaiming the word of the Lord, with many others also. ³⁶After some days Paul said to Barnabas, "Let's return now and visit our brothers in every city in which we proclaimed the word of the Lord, to see how they are doing." ³⁷Barnabas planned to take Yochanan, who was called Mark, with them also. ³⁸But Paul didn't think that it was a good idea to take with them someone who had withdrawn from them in Pamphylia, and didn't go with them to do the work. ³⁹Then the contention grew so sharp that they separated from each other. Barnabas took Mark with him and sailed away to Cyprus, ⁴⁰but Paul chose Silas and went out, being commended by the brothers to the grace of God. ⁴¹He went through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the assemblies.

16He came to Derbe and Lystra; and behold, a certain disciple was there, named Timothy, the son of a Jewess who believed, but his father was a Greek. ²The brothers who were at Lystra and Iconium gave a good testimony about him. ³Paul wanted to have him go out with him, and he took and circumcised him because of the Jews who were in those parts, for they all knew that his father was a Greek. ⁴As they went on their way through the cities, they delivered the decrees to them to keep which had been ordained by the emissaries and elders who were at Jerusalem. ⁵So the assemblies were strengthened in the faith, and increased in number daily. ⁶When they had gone through the region of Phrygia and Galatia, they were forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia. ⁷When they had come opposite Mysia, they tried to go into Bithynia, but the Spirit didn't allow them. ⁸Passing by Mysia, they came down to Troas. ⁹A vision appeared to Paul in the night. There was a man of Macedonia standing, begging him and saying, "Come over into Macedonia and help us." ¹⁰When he had seen the vision, immediately we sought to go out to Macedonia, concluding that the Lord had called us to proclaim the Good News to them. ¹¹Setting sail therefore from Troas, we made a straight course to Samothrace, and the day following to Neapolis; ¹²and from there to Philippi, which is a city of Macedonia, the foremost of the district, a Roman colony. We were staying some days in this city. ¹³On the Sabbath day we went outside of the city by a riverside, where we supposed there was a place of prayer, and we sat down and spoke to the women who had come together. ¹⁴A certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, one who worshiped God, heard us. The Lord opened her heart to listen to the things which

were spoken by Paul. ¹⁵When she and her household were immersed, she begged us, saying, "If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and stay." So she persuaded us. ¹⁶As we were going to prayer, a certain girl having a spirit of divination met us, who brought her masters much gain by fortune telling. ¹⁷Following Paul and us, she cried out, "These men are servants of the Most High God, who proclaim to us a way of salvation!" ¹⁸She was doing this for many days. But Paul, becoming greatly annoyed, turned and said to the spirit, "I command you in the name of Yeshua the Messiah to come out of her!" It came out that very hour. ¹⁹But when her masters saw that the hope of their gain was gone, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them into the marketplace before the rulers. ²⁰When they had brought them to the magistrates, they said, "These men, being Jews, are agitating our city ²¹and advocate customs which it is not lawful for us to accept or to observe, being Romans." ²²The multitude rose up together against them and the magistrates tore their clothes from them, then commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely. ²⁴Having received such a command, he threw them into the inner prison and secured their feet in the stocks. ²⁵But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened. ²⁷The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, "Don't harm yourself, for we are all here!" ²⁹He called for lights, sprang in, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰brought them out, and said, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?" ³¹They said, "Believe in the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, and you will be saved, you and your household." ³²They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³He took them the same hour of the night and washed their stripes, and was immediately immersed, he and all his household. ³⁴He brought them up into his house and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly with all his household, having believed in God. ³⁵But when it was day, the magistrates sent the sergeants, saying, "Let those men go." ³⁶The jailer reported these words to Paul, saying, "The magistrates have sent to let you go; now therefore come out and go in peace." ³⁷But Paul said to them, "They have beaten us publicly without a trial, men who are Romans, and have cast us into prison! Do they now release us secretly? No, most certainly, but let them come themselves and bring us out!" ³⁸The sergeants reported these words to the magistrates, and they were afraid when they heard that they were Romans, ³⁹and they came and

^{xliii}Some manuscripts add:

begged them. When they had brought them out, they asked them to depart from the city. ⁴⁰They went out of the prison and entered into Lydia's house. When they had seen the brothers, they encouraged them, then departed.

17Now when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where there was a Jewish synagogue. ²Paul, as was his custom, went in to them; and for three Sabbath days reasoned with them from the Scriptures, ³explaining and demonstrating that the Messiah had to suffer and rise again from the dead, and saying, "This Yeshua, whom I proclaim to you, is the Messiah." ⁴Some of them were persuaded and joined Paul and Silas: of the devout Greeks a great multitude, and not a few of the chief women. ⁵But the unpersuaded Jews took along ^{xliv} some wicked men from the marketplace and gathering a crowd, set the city in an uproar. Assaulting the house of Jason, they sought to bring them out to the people. ⁶When they didn't find them, they dragged Jason and certain brothers ^{xliv} before the rulers of the city, crying, "These who have turned the world upside down have come here also, ⁷whom Jason has received. These all act contrary to the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king, Yeshua!" ⁸The multitude and the rulers of the city were troubled when they heard these things. ⁹When they had taken security from Jason and the rest, they let them go. ¹⁰The brothers immediately sent Paul and Silas away by night to Beroea. When they arrived, they went into the Jewish synagogue. ¹¹Now these were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, examining the Scriptures daily to see whether these things were so. ¹²Many of them therefore believed; also of the prominent Greek women, and not a few men. ¹³But when the Jews of Thessalonica had knowledge that the word of God was proclaimed by Paul at Beroea also, they came there likewise, agitating the multitudes. ¹⁴Then the brothers immediately sent out Paul to go as far as to the sea, and Silas and Timothy still stayed there. ¹⁵But those who escorted Paul brought him as far as Athens. Receiving a commandment to Silas and Timothy that they should come to him very quickly, they departed. ¹⁶Now while Paul waited for them at Athens, his spirit was provoked within him as he saw the city full of idols. ¹⁷So he reasoned in the synagogue with the Jews and the devout persons, and in the marketplace every day with those who met him. ¹⁸Some of the Epicurean and Stoic philosophers also ^{xlvi} were conversing with him. Some said, "What does this babbler want to say?" Others said, "He seems to be advocating foreign deities," because

he preached Yeshua and the resurrection. ¹⁹They took hold of him and brought him to the Areopagus, saying, "May we know what this new teaching is, which you are speaking about?" ²⁰For you bring certain strange things to our ears. We want to know therefore what these things mean." ²¹Now all the Athenians and the strangers living there spent their time in nothing else, but either to tell or to hear some new thing. ²²Paul stood in the middle of the Areopagus and said, "You men of Athens, I perceive that you are very religious in all things. ²³For as I passed along and observed the objects of your worship, I also found an altar with this inscription: 'TO AN UNKNOWN GOD.' What therefore you worship in ignorance, I announce to you. ²⁴The God who made the world and all things in it, he, being Lord of heaven and earth, doesn't dwell in temples made with hands. ²⁵He isn't served by men's hands, as though he needed anything, seeing he himself gives to all life and breath and all things. ²⁶He made from one blood every nation of men to dwell on all the surface of the earth, having determined appointed seasons and the boundaries of their dwellings, ²⁷that they should seek the Lord, if perhaps they might reach out for him and find him, though he is not far from each one of us. ²⁸'For in him we live, move, and have our being.' As some of your own poets have said, 'For we are also his offspring.' ²⁹Being then the offspring of God, we ought not to think that the Divine Nature is like gold, or silver, or stone, engraved by art and design of man. ³⁰The times of ignorance therefore God overlooked. But now he commands that all people everywhere should repent, ³¹because he has appointed a day in which he will judge the world in righteousness by the man whom he has ordained; of which he has given assurance to all men, in that he has raised him from the dead." ³²Now when they heard of the resurrection of the dead, some mocked; but others said, "We want to hear you again concerning this." ³³Thus Paul went out from among them. ³⁴But certain men joined with him and believed, including Dionysius the Areopagite, and a woman named Damaris, and others with them.

18After these things Paul departed from Athens and came to Corinth. ²He found a certain Jew named Aquila, a man of Pontus by race, who had recently come from Italy with his wife Priscilla, because Claudius had commanded all the Jews to depart from Rome. He came to them, ³and because he practiced the same trade, he lived with them and worked, for by trade they were tent makers. ⁴He reasoned in the synagogue every Sabbath and persuaded Jews and Greeks. ⁵When Silas and Timothy came down from Macedonia, Paul was compelled by the Spirit, testifying to the Jews that Yeshua was the Messiah. ⁶When they opposed him and blasphemed, he shook out his clothing and said to them, "Your blood be on your own heads! I am clean. From now on, I will go to the Gentiles!" ⁷He

^{xliv}TR reads "And the Jews who were unpersuaded, becoming envious and taking along" instead of "But the unpersuaded Jews took along"

^{xliv}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{xlvi}TR omits "also"

departed there and went into the house of a certain man named Justus, one who worshiped God, whose house was next door to the synagogue. ⁸Crispus, the ruler of the synagogue, believed in the Lord with all his house. Many of the Corinthians, when they heard, believed and were immersed. ⁹The Lord said to Paul in the night by a vision, “Don’t be afraid, but speak and don’t be silent; ¹⁰for I am with you, and no one will attack you to harm you, for I have many people in this city.” ¹¹He lived there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them. ¹²But when Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews with one accord rose up against Paul and brought him before the judgment seat, ¹³saying, “This man persuades men to worship God contrary to the law.” ¹⁴But when Paul was about to open his mouth, Gallio said to the Jews, “If indeed it were a matter of wrong or of wicked crime, you Jews, it would be reasonable that I should bear with you; ¹⁵but if they are questions about words and names and your own law, look to it yourselves. For I don’t want to be a judge of these matters.” ¹⁶So he drove them from the judgment seat. ¹⁷Then all the Greeks seized Sosthenes, the ruler of the synagogue, and beat him before the judgment seat. Gallio didn’t care about any of these things. ¹⁸Paul, having stayed after this many more days, took his leave of the brothers, ^{xlvii} and sailed from there for Syria, together with Priscilla and Aquila. He shaved his head in Cenchreae, for he had a vow. ¹⁹He came to Ephesus, and he left them there; but he himself entered into the synagogue and reasoned with the Jews. ²⁰When they asked him to stay with them a longer time, he declined; ²¹but taking his leave of them, he said, “I must by all means keep this coming feast in Jerusalem, but I will return again to you if God wills.” Then he set sail from Ephesus. ²²When he had landed at Caesarea, he went up and greeted the assembly, and went down to Antioch. ²³Having spent some time there, he departed and went through the region of Galatia and Phrygia, in order, establishing all the disciples. ²⁴Now a certain Jew named Apollos, an Alexandrian by race, an eloquent man, came to Ephesus. He was mighty in the Scriptures. ²⁵This man had been instructed in the way of the Lord; and being fervent in spirit, he spoke and taught accurately the things concerning Yeshua, although he knew only the immersion of Yochanan. ²⁶He began to speak boldly in the synagogue. But when Priscilla and Aquila heard him, they took him aside, and explained to him the way of God more accurately. ²⁷When he had determined to pass over into Achaia, the brothers encouraged him; and wrote to the disciples to receive him. When he had come, he greatly helped those who had believed through grace; ²⁸for he powerfully refuted the Jews, publicly showing by the Scriptures that Yeshua was the Messiah.

¹⁹While Apollos was at Corinth, Paul, having passed through the upper country, came to Ephesus and found certain disciples. ²He said to them, “Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?” They said to him, “No, we haven’t even heard that there is a Holy Spirit.” ³He said, “Into what then were you immersed?” They said, “Into Yochanan’s immersion.” ⁴Paul said, “Yochanan indeed immersed with the immersion of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe in the one who would come after him, that is, in Yeshua.” ⁵When they heard this, they were immersed in the name of the Lord Yeshua. ⁶When Paul had laid his hands on them, the Holy Spirit came on them and they spoke with other languages and prophesied. ⁷They were about twelve men in all. ⁸He entered into the synagogue and spoke boldly for a period of three months, reasoning and persuading about the things concerning God’s Kingdom. ⁹But when some were hardened and disobedient, speaking evil of the Way before the multitude, he departed from them and separated the disciples, reasoning daily in the school of Tyrannus. ¹⁰This continued for two years, so that all those who lived in Asia heard the word of the Lord Yeshua, both Jews and Greeks. ¹¹God worked special miracles by the hands of Paul, ¹²so that even handkerchiefs or aprons were carried away from his body to the sick, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out. ¹³But some of the itinerant Jews, exorcists, took on themselves to invoke over those who had the evil spirits the name of the Lord Yeshua, saying, “We adjure you by Yeshua whom Paul preaches.” ¹⁴There were seven sons of one Sceva, a Jewish chief priest, who did this. ¹⁵The evil spirit answered, “Yeshua I know, and Paul I know, but who are you?” ¹⁶The man in whom the evil spirit was leaped on them, overpowered them, and prevailed against them, so that they fled out of that house naked and wounded. ¹⁷This became known to all, both Jews and Greeks, who lived at Ephesus. Fear fell on them all, and the name of the Lord Yeshua was magnified. ¹⁸Many also of those who had believed came, confessing and declaring their deeds. ¹⁹Many of those who practiced magical arts brought their books together and burned them in the sight of all. They counted their price, and found it to be fifty thousand pieces of silver. ^{xlviii} ²⁰So the word of the Lord was growing and becoming mighty. ²¹Now after these things had ended, Paul determined in the Spirit, when he had passed through Macedonia and Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying, “After I have been there, I must also see Rome.” ²²Having sent into Macedonia two of those who served him, Timothy and Erastus, he himself stayed in Asia for a while. ²³About that time there arose no small disturbance concerning the Way. ²⁴For a certain man named Demetrius,

^{xlvii}The word for “brothers” here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

^{xlviii}The 50,000 pieces of silver here probably referred to 50,000 drachmas. If so, the value of the burned books was equivalent to about 160 man-years of wages for agricultural laborers

a silversmith who made silver shrines of Artemis, brought no little business to the craftsmen,²⁵ whom he gathered together with the workmen of like occupation, and said, "Sirs, you know that by this business we have our wealth.²⁶ You see and hear that not at Ephesus alone, but almost throughout all Asia, this Paul has persuaded and turned away many people, saying that they are no gods that are made with hands.²⁷ Not only is there danger that this our trade come into disrepute, but also that the temple of the great goddess Artemis will be counted as nothing and her majesty destroyed, whom all Asia and the world worships."²⁸ When they heard this they were filled with anger, and cried out, saying, "Great is Artemis of the Ephesians!"²⁹ The whole city was filled with confusion, and they rushed with one accord into the theater, having seized Gaius and Aristarchus, men of Macedonia, Paul's companions in travel.³⁰ When Paul wanted to enter in to the people, the disciples didn't allow him.³¹ Certain also of the Asiarchs, being his friends, sent to him and begged him not to venture into the theater.³² Some therefore cried one thing, and some another, for the assembly was in confusion. Most of them didn't know why they had come together.³³ They brought Alexander out of the multitude, the Jews putting him forward. Alexander beckoned with his hand, and would have made a defense to the people.³⁴ But when they perceived that he was a Jew, all with one voice for a time of about two hours cried out, "Great is Artemis of the Ephesians!"³⁵ When the town clerk had quieted the multitude, he said, "You men of Ephesus, what man is there who doesn't know that the city of the Ephesians is temple keeper of the great goddess Artemis, and of the image which fell down from Zeus?"³⁶ Seeing then that these things can't be denied, you ought to be quiet and to do nothing rash.³⁷ For you have brought these men here, who are neither robbers of temples nor blasphemers of your goddess.³⁸ If therefore Demetrius and the craftsmen who are with him have a matter against anyone, the courts are open and there are proconsuls. Let them press charges against one another.³⁹ But if you seek anything about other matters, it will be settled in the regular assembly.⁴⁰ For indeed we are in danger of being accused concerning today's riot, there being no cause. Concerning it, we wouldn't be able to give an account of this commotion."⁴¹ When he had thus spoken, he dismissed the assembly.

20 After the uproar had ceased, Paul sent for the disciples, took leave of them, and departed to go into Macedonia.² When he had gone through those parts and had encouraged them with many words, he came into Greece.³ When he had spent three months there, and a plot was made against him by Jews as he was about to set sail for Syria, he determined to return through Macedonia.⁴ These accompanied him as far as Asia: Sopater of Beroea,

Aristarchus and Secundus of the Thessalonians, Gaius of Derbe, Timothy, and Tychicus and Trophimus of Asia.⁵ But these had gone ahead, and were waiting for us at Troas.⁶ We sailed away from Philippi after the days of Unleavened Bread, and came to them at Troas in five days, where we stayed seven days.⁷ On the first day of the week, when the disciples were gathered together to break bread, Paul talked with them, intending to depart on the next day; and continued his speech until midnight.⁸ There were many lights in the upper room where we ^{xlix} were gathered together.⁹ A certain young man named Eutychus sat in the window, weighed down with deep sleep. As Paul spoke still longer, being weighed down by his sleep, he fell down from the third floor and was taken up dead.¹⁰ Paul went down and fell upon him, and embracing him said, "Don't be troubled, for his life is in him."¹¹ When he had gone up, had broken bread and eaten, and had talked with them a long while, even until break of day, he departed.¹² They brought the boy in alive, and were greatly comforted.¹³ But we, going ahead to the ship, set sail for Assos, intending to take Paul aboard there; for he had so arranged, intending himself to go by land.¹⁴ When he met us at Assos, we took him aboard and came to Mitylene.¹⁵ Sailing from there, we came the following day opposite Chios. The next day we touched at Samos and stayed at Trogyllium, and the day after we came to Miletus.¹⁶ For Paul had determined to sail past Ephesus, that he might not have to spend time in Asia; for he was hastening, if it were possible for him, to be in Jerusalem on the day of Shavu'ot.¹⁷ From Miletus he sent to Ephesus and called to himself the elders of the assembly.¹⁸ When they had come to him, he said to them, "You yourselves know, from the first day that I set foot in Asia, how I was with you all the time,¹⁹ serving the Lord with all humility, with many tears, and with trials which happened to me by the plots of the Jews;²⁰ how I didn't shrink from declaring to you anything that was profitable, teaching you publicly and from house to house,²¹ testifying both to Jews and to Greeks repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Yeshua.¹ ²² Now, behold, I go bound by the Spirit to Jerusalem, not knowing what will happen to me there;²³ except that the Holy Spirit testifies in every city, saying that bonds and afflictions wait for me.²⁴ But these things don't count; nor do I hold my life dear to myself, so that I may finish my race with joy, and the ministry which I received from the Lord Yeshua, to fully testify to the Good News of the grace of God.²⁵ "Now, behold, I know that you all, among whom I went about proclaiming God's Kingdom, will see my face no more.²⁶ Therefore I testify to you today that I am clean from the blood of all men,²⁷ for I didn't shrink from declaring to you the whole counsel of God.²⁸ Take heed, therefore, to yourselves and to all

^{xlix}TR reads "they" instead of "we"

¹TR adds "Messiah"

the flock, in which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers, to shepherd the assembly of the Lord and ^{li} God which he purchased with his own blood. ²⁹For I know that after my departure, vicious wolves will enter in among you, not sparing the flock. ³⁰Men will arise from among your own selves, speaking perverse things, to draw away the disciples after them. ³¹Therefore watch, remembering that for a period of three years I didn't cease to admonish everyone night and day with tears. ³²Now, brothers, ^{lii} I entrust you to God and to the word of his grace, which is able to build up and to give you the inheritance among all those who are sanctified. ³³I coveted no one's silver, gold, or clothing. ³⁴You yourselves know that these hands served my necessities, and those who were with me. ³⁵In all things I gave you an example, that so laboring you ought to help the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Yeshua, that he himself said, "It is more blessed to give than to receive." ³⁶When he had spoken these things, he knelt down and prayed with them all. ³⁷They all wept freely, and fell on Paul's neck and kissed him, ³⁸sorrowing most of all because of the word which he had spoken, that they should see his face no more. Then they accompanied him to the ship.

21When we had departed from them and had set sail, we came with a straight course to Cos, and the next day to Rhodes, and from there to Patara. ²Having found a ship crossing over to Phoenicia, we went aboard and set sail. ³When we had come in sight of Cyprus, leaving it on the left hand, we sailed to Syria and landed at Tyre, for the ship was there to unload her cargo. ⁴Having found disciples, we stayed there seven days. These said to Paul through the Spirit that he should not go up to Jerusalem. ⁵When those days were over, we departed and went on our journey. They all, with wives and children, brought us on our way until we were out of the city. Kneeling down on the beach, we prayed. ⁶After saying goodbye to each other, we went on board the ship, and they returned home again. ⁷When we had finished the voyage from Tyre, we arrived at Ptolemais. We greeted the brothers and stayed with them one day. ⁸On the next day, we who were Paul's companions departed and came to Caesarea. We entered into the house of Philip the evangelist, who was one of the seven, and stayed with him. ⁹Now this man had four virgin daughters who prophesied. ¹⁰As we stayed there some days, a certain prophet named Agabus came down from Judea. ¹¹Coming to us and taking Paul's belt, he bound his own feet and hands, and said, "The Holy Spirit says: 'So the Judeans at Jerusalem will bind the man who owns this belt, and will deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles.'" ¹²When we heard these things, both we and the

people of that place begged him not to go up to Jerusalem. ¹³Then Paul answered, "What are you doing, weeping and breaking my heart? For I am ready not only to be bound, but also to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Yeshua." ¹⁴When he would not be persuaded, we ceased, saying, "The Lord's will be done." ¹⁵After these days we took up our baggage and went up to Jerusalem. ¹⁶Some of the disciples from Caesarea also went with us, bringing one Mnason of Cyprus, an early disciple, with whom we would stay. ¹⁷When we had come to Jerusalem, the brothers received us gladly. ¹⁸The day following, Paul went in with us to Jacob; and all the elders were present. ¹⁹When he had greeted them, he reported one by one the things which God had worked among the Gentiles through his ministry. ²⁰They, when they heard it, glorified God. They said to him, "You see, brother, how many thousands there are among the Judeans of those who have believed, and they are all zealous for the Torah." ²¹They have been informed about you, that you teach all the Jews who are among the Gentiles to forsake Moses, telling them not to circumcise their children and not to walk after the customs. ²²What then? The assembly must certainly meet, for they will hear that you have come. ²³Therefore do what we tell you. We have four men who have taken a vow. ²⁴Take them and purify yourself with them, and pay their expenses for them, that they may shave their heads. Then all will know that there is no truth in the things that they have been informed about you, but that you yourself also walk keeping the Torah. ²⁵But concerning the Gentiles who believe, we have written our decision that they should observe no such thing, except that they should keep themselves from food offered to idols, from blood, from strangled things, and from sexual immorality." ²⁶Then Paul took the men, and the next day purified himself and went with them into the temple, declaring the fulfillment of the days of purification, until the offering was offered for every one of them. ²⁷When the seven days were almost completed, the Jews from Asia, when they saw him in the temple, stirred up all the multitude and laid hands on him, ²⁸crying out, "Men of Israel, help! This is the man who teaches all men everywhere against the people, and the Torah, and this place. Moreover, he also brought Greeks into the temple and has defiled this holy place!" ²⁹For they had seen Trophimus the Ephesian, with him in the city, and they supposed that Paul had brought him into the temple. ³⁰All the city was moved and the people ran together. They seized Paul and dragged him out of the temple. Immediately the doors were shut. ³¹As they were trying to kill him, news came up to the commanding officer of the regiment that all Jerusalem was in an uproar. ³²Immediately he took soldiers and centurions and ran down to them. They, when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, stopped beating Paul. ³³Then the commanding officer came near, arrested him, commanded him

^{li}TR, NU omit "the Lord and"

^{lii}The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

to be bound with two chains, and inquired who he was and what he had done. ³⁴Some shouted one thing and some another, among the crowd. When he couldn't find out the truth because of the noise, he commanded him to be brought into the barracks. ³⁵When he came to the stairs, he was carried by the soldiers because of the violence of the crowd; ³⁶for the multitude of the people followed after, crying out, "Away with him!" ³⁷As Paul was about to be brought into the barracks, he asked the commanding officer, "May I speak to you?" He said, "Do you know Greek? ³⁸Aren't you then the Egyptian who before these days stirred up to sedition and led out into the wilderness the four thousand men of the Assassins?" ³⁹But Paul said, "I am a Jew from Tarsus in Cilicia, a citizen of no insignificant city. I beg you, allow me to speak to the people." ⁴⁰When he had given him permission, Paul, standing on the stairs, beckoned with his hand to the people. When there was a great silence, he spoke to them in the Hebrew language, saying,

22"Brothers and fathers, listen to the defense which I now make to you." ²When they heard that he spoke to them in the Hebrew language, they were even more quiet. He said, ³"I am indeed a Jew, born in Tarsus of Cilicia, but brought up in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, instructed according to the strict tradition of the law of our fathers, being zealous for God, even as you all are today. ⁴I persecuted this Way to the death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women, ⁵as also the high priest and all the council of the elders testify, from whom also I received letters to the brothers, and traveled to Damascus to bring them also who were there to Jerusalem in bonds to be punished. ⁶"As I made my journey and came close to Damascus, about noon suddenly a great light shone around me from the sky. ⁷I fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to me, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?' ⁸I answered, 'Who are you, Lord?' He said to me, 'I am Yeshua of Nazareth, whom you persecute.' ⁹"Those who were with me indeed saw the light and were afraid, but they didn't understand the voice of him who spoke to me. ¹⁰I said, 'What shall I do, Lord?' The Lord said to me, 'Arise, and go into Damascus. There you will be told about all things which are appointed for you to do.' ¹¹When I couldn't see for the glory of that light, being led by the hand of those who were with me, I came into Damascus. ¹²"One Hananiah, a devout man according to the Torah, well reported of by all the Jews who lived in Damascus, ¹³came to me, and standing by me said to me, 'Brother Saul, receive your sight!' In that very hour I looked up at him. ¹⁴He said, 'The God of our fathers has appointed you to know his will, and to see the Righteous One, and to hear a voice from his mouth. ¹⁵For you will be a witness for him to all men of what you have seen and heard. ¹⁶Now why do you wait? Arise, be immersed, and wash away

your sins, calling on the name of the Lord.' ¹⁷"When I had returned to Jerusalem and while I prayed in the temple, I fell into a trance ¹⁸and saw him saying to me, 'Hurry and get out of Jerusalem quickly, because they will not receive testimony concerning me from you.' ¹⁹I said, 'Lord, they themselves know that I imprisoned and beat in every synagogue those who believed in you. ²⁰When the blood of Stephen, your witness, was shed, I also was standing by, consenting to his death, and guarding the cloaks of those who killed him.' ²¹"He said to me, 'Depart, for I will send you out far from here to the Gentiles.' ²²They listened to him until he said that; then they lifted up their voice and said, "Rid the earth of this fellow, for he isn't fit to live!" ²³As they cried out, threw off their cloaks, and threw dust into the air, ²⁴the commanding officer commanded him to be brought into the barracks, ordering him to be examined by scourging, that he might know for what crime they shouted against him like that. ²⁵When they had tied him up with thongs, Paul asked the centurion who stood by, "Is it lawful for you to scourge a man who is a Roman, and not found guilty?" ²⁶When the centurion heard it, he went to the commanding officer and told him, "Watch what you are about to do, for this man is a Roman!" ²⁷The commanding officer came and asked him, "Tell me, are you a Roman?" He said, "Yes." ²⁸The commanding officer answered, "I bought my citizenship for a great price." Paul said, "But I was born a Roman." ²⁹Immediately those who were about to examine him departed from him, and the commanding officer also was afraid when he realized that he was a Roman, because he had bound him. ³⁰But on the next day, desiring to know the truth about why he was accused by the Judeans, he freed him from the bonds and commanded the chief priests and all the council to come together, and brought Paul down and set him before them.

23Paul, looking steadfastly at the council, said, "Brothers, I have lived before God in all good conscience until today." ²The high priest, Ananias, commanded those who stood by him to strike him on the mouth. ³Then Paul said to him, "God will strike you, you whitewashed wall! Do you sit to judge me according to the Torah, and command me to be struck contrary to the law?" ⁴Those who stood by said, "Do you malign God's high priest?" ⁵Paul said, "I didn't know, brothers, that he was high priest. For it is written, 'You shall not speak evil of a ruler of your people.'" ⁶But when Paul perceived that the one part were Sadducees and the other Pharisees, he cried out in the council, "Men and brothers, I am a Pharisee, a son of Pharisees. Concerning the hope and resurrection of the dead I am being judged!" ⁷When he had said this, an argument arose between the Pharisees and Sadducees, and the crowd was divided. ⁸For the Sadducees say that there is no resurrection, nor angel, nor spirit; but the Pharisees

confess all of these. ⁹A great clamor arose, and some of the scribes of the Pharisees' part stood up, and contended, saying, "We find no evil in this man. But if a spirit or angel has spoken to him, let's not fight against God!" ¹⁰When a great argument arose, the commanding officer, fearing that Paul would be torn in pieces by them, commanded the soldiers to go down and take him by force from among them and bring him into the barracks. ¹¹The following night, the Lord stood by him and said, "Cheer up, Paul, for as you have testified about me at Jerusalem, so you must testify also at Rome." ¹²When it was day, some of the Judeans banded together and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink until they had killed Paul. ¹³There were more than forty people who had made this conspiracy. ¹⁴They came to the chief priests and the elders, and said, "We have bound ourselves under a great curse to taste nothing until we have killed Paul. ¹⁵Now therefore, you with the council inform the commanding officer that he should bring him down to you tomorrow, as though you were going to judge his case more exactly. We are ready to kill him before he comes near." ¹⁶But Paul's sister's son heard they were lying in wait, and he came and entered into the barracks and told Paul. ¹⁷Paul summoned one of the centurions and said, "Bring this young man to the commanding officer, for he has something to tell him." ¹⁸So he took him and brought him to the commanding officer and said, "Paul, the prisoner, summoned me and asked me to bring this young man to you. He has something to tell you." ¹⁹The commanding officer took him by the hand, and going aside, asked him privately, "What is it that you have to tell me?" ²⁰He said, "The Judeans have agreed to ask you to bring Paul down to the council tomorrow, as though intending to inquire somewhat more accurately concerning him. ²¹Therefore don't yield to them, for more than forty men lie in wait for him, who have bound themselves under a curse to neither eat nor drink until they have killed him. Now they are ready, looking for the promise from you." ²²So the commanding officer let the young man go, charging him, "Tell no one that you have revealed these things to me." ²³He called to himself two of the centurions, and said, "Prepare two hundred soldiers to go as far as Caesarea, with seventy horsemen and two hundred men armed with spears, at the third hour of the night." ^{liii} ²⁴He asked them to provide mounts, that they might set Paul on one, and bring him safely to Felix the governor. ²⁵He wrote a letter like this: ²⁶"Claudius Lysias to the most excellent governor Felix: Greetings. ²⁷"This man was seized by the Judeans, and was about to be killed by them when I came with the soldiers and rescued him, having learned that he was a Roman. ²⁸Desiring to know the cause why they accused him, I brought him down to their council. ²⁹I found him to be accused about questions of their law, but not to

be charged with anything worthy of death or of imprisonment. ³⁰When I was told that the Judeans lay in wait for the man, I sent him to you immediately, charging his accusers also to bring their accusations against him before you. Farewell." ³¹So the soldiers, carrying out their orders, took Paul and brought him by night to Antipatris. ³²But on the next day they left the horsemen to go with him, and returned to the barracks. ³³When they came to Caesarea and delivered the letter to the governor, they also presented Paul to him. ³⁴When the governor had read it, he asked what province he was from. When he understood that he was from Cilicia, he said, ³⁵"I will hear you fully when your accusers also arrive." He commanded that he be kept in Herod's palace.

24After five days, the high priest, Ananias, came down with certain elders and an orator, one Tertullus. They informed the governor against Paul. ²When he was called, Tertullus began to accuse him, saying, "Seeing that by you we enjoy much peace, and that prosperity is coming to this nation by your foresight, ³we accept it in all ways and in all places, most excellent Felix, with all thankfulness. ⁴But that I don't delay you, I entreat you to bear with us and hear a few words. ⁵For we have found this man to be a plague, an instigator of insurrections among all the Jews throughout the world, and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes. ⁶He even tried to profane the temple, and we arrested him. ^{liv} ^{7lv} ^{8lvi} By examining him yourself you may ascertain all these things of which we accuse him." ⁹The Judeans also joined in the attack, affirming that these things were so. ¹⁰When the governor had beckoned to him to speak, Paul answered, "Because I know that you have been a judge of this nation for many years, I cheerfully make my defense, ¹¹seeing that you can verify that it is not more than twelve days since I went up to worship at Jerusalem. ¹²In the temple they didn't find me disputing with anyone or stirring up a crowd, either in the synagogues or in the city. ¹³Nor can they prove to you the things of which they now accuse me. ¹⁴But this I confess to you, that according to the Way, which they call a sect, so I serve the God of our fathers, believing all things which are according to the Torah, and which are written in the Prophets; ¹⁵having hope toward God, which these also themselves look for, that there will be a resurrection of the dead, both of the just and unjust. ¹⁶In this I also practice always having a conscience void of offense toward God and men. ¹⁷Now after some years, I came to bring gifts for the needy to my nation, and offerings; ¹⁸amid which certain Jews from Asia found me purified in the temple, not with a mob, nor with turmoil. ¹⁹They

^{liii}about 9:00 p.m.

^{liv}TR adds "We wanted to judge him according to our law,"

^{lv}TR adds "but the commanding officer, Lysias, came by and with great violence took him out of our hands,"

^{lvi}TR adds "commanding his accusers to come to you."

ought to have been here before you and to make accusation if they had anything against me. ²⁰Or else let these men themselves say what injustice they found in me when I stood before the council, ²¹unless it is for this one thing that I cried standing among them, ‘Concerning the resurrection of the dead I am being judged before you today!’” ²²But Felix, having more exact knowledge concerning the Way, deferred them, saying, “When Lysias, the commanding officer, comes down, I will decide your case.” ²³He ordered the centurion that Paul should be kept in custody and should have some privileges, and not to forbid any of his friends to serve him or to visit him. ²⁴After some days, Felix came with Drusilla his wife, who was a Jewess, and sent for Paul and heard him concerning the faith in Messiah Yeshua. ²⁵As he reasoned about righteousness, self-control, and the judgment to come, Felix was terrified, and answered, “Go your way for this time, and when it is convenient for me, I will summon you.” ²⁶Meanwhile, he also hoped that money would be given to him by Paul, that he might release him. Therefore also he sent for him more often and talked with him. ²⁷But when two years were fulfilled, Felix was succeeded by Porcius Festus, and desiring to gain favor with the Judeans, Felix left Paul in bonds.

25Festus therefore, having come into the province, after three days went up to Jerusalem from Caesarea. ²Then the high priest and the principal men of the Judeans informed him against Paul, and they begged him, ³asking a favor against him, that he would summon him to Jerusalem, plotting to kill him on the way. ⁴However Festus answered that Paul should be kept in custody at Caesarea, and that he himself was about to depart shortly. ⁵“Let them therefore”, he said, “that are in power among you go down with me, and if there is anything wrong in the man, let them accuse him.” ⁶When he had stayed among them more than ten days, he went down to Caesarea, and on the next day he sat on the judgment seat, and commanded Paul to be brought. ⁷When he had come, the Judeans who had come down from Jerusalem stood around him, bringing against him many and grievous charges which they could not prove, ⁸while he said in his defense, “Neither against the law of the Jews, nor against the temple, nor against Caesar, have I sinned at all.” ⁹But Festus, desiring to gain favor with the Judeans, answered Paul and said, “Are you willing to go up to Jerusalem and be judged by me there concerning these things?” ¹⁰But Paul said, “I am standing before Caesar’s judgment seat, where I ought to be tried. I have done no wrong to the Judeans, as you also know very well. ¹¹For if I have done wrong and have committed anything worthy of death, I don’t refuse to die; but if none of those things is true that they accuse me of, no one can give me up to them. I appeal to Caesar!” ¹²Then Festus, when he had conferred with the council, answered, “You have appealed

to Caesar. To Caesar you shall go.” ¹³Now when some days had passed, King Agrippa and Bernice arrived at Caesarea and greeted Festus. ¹⁴As he stayed there many days, Festus laid Paul’s case before the king, saying, “There is a certain man left a prisoner by Felix; ¹⁵about whom, when I was at Jerusalem, the chief priests and the Jewish elders informed me, asking for a sentence against him. ¹⁶I answered them that it is not the custom of the Romans to give up any man to destruction before the accused has met the accusers face to face and has had opportunity to make his defense concerning the matter laid against him. ¹⁷When therefore they had come together here, I didn’t delay, but on the next day sat on the judgment seat and commanded the man to be brought. ¹⁸When the accusers stood up, they brought no charges against him of such things as I supposed; ¹⁹but had certain questions against him about their own religion and about one Yeshua, who was dead, whom Paul affirmed to be alive. ²⁰Being perplexed how to inquire concerning these things, I asked whether he was willing to go to Jerusalem and there be judged concerning these matters. ²¹But when Paul had appealed to be kept for the decision of the emperor, I commanded him to be kept until I could send him to Caesar.” ²²Agrippa said to Festus, “I also would like to hear the man myself.” “Tomorrow,” he said, “you shall hear him.” ²³So on the next day, when Agrippa and Bernice had come with great pomp, and they had entered into the place of hearing with the commanding officers and the principal men of the city, at the command of Festus, Paul was brought in. ²⁴Festus said, “King Agrippa, and all men who are here present with us, you see this man about whom all the multitude of the Judeans petitioned me, both at Jerusalem and here, crying that he ought not to live any longer. ²⁵But when I found that he had committed nothing worthy of death, and as he himself appealed to the emperor, I determined to send him, ²⁶of whom I have no certain thing to write to my lord. Therefore I have brought him out before you, and especially before you, King Agrippa, that, after examination I may have something to write. ²⁷For it seems to me unreasonable, in sending a prisoner, not to also specify the charges against him.”

26Agrippa said to Paul, “You may speak for yourself.” Then Paul stretched out his hand, and made his defense. ²“I think myself happy, King Agrippa, that I am to make my defense before you today concerning all the things that I am accused by the Judeans, ³especially because you are expert in all customs and questions which are among Jews. Therefore I beg you to hear me patiently. ⁴“Indeed, all Jews know my way of life from my youth up, which was from the beginning among my own nation and at Jerusalem; ⁵having known me from the first, if they are willing to testify, that after the strictest sect of our religion I lived a Pharisee. ⁶Now I stand here to be judged

for the hope of the promise made by God to our fathers, ⁷which our twelve tribes, earnestly serving night and day, hope to attain. Concerning this hope I am accused by the Judeans, King Agrippa! ⁸Why is it judged incredible with you if God does raise the dead? ⁹"I myself most certainly thought that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Yeshua of Nazareth. ¹⁰I also did this in Jerusalem. I both shut up many of the holy ones in prisons, having received authority from the chief priests; and when they were put to death I gave my vote against them. ¹¹Punishing them often in all the synagogues, I tried to make them blaspheme. Being exceedingly enraged against them, I persecuted them even to foreign cities. ¹²"Whereupon as I traveled to Damascus with the authority and commission from the chief priests, ¹³at noon, O king, I saw on the way a light from the sky, brighter than the sun, shining around me and those who traveled with me. ¹⁴When we had all fallen to the earth, I heard a voice saying to me in the Hebrew language, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me? It is hard for you to kick against the goads.' ¹⁵"I said, 'Who are you, Lord?' "He said, 'I am Yeshua, whom you are persecuting. ¹⁶But arise, and stand on your feet, for I have appeared to you for this purpose: to appoint you a servant and a witness both of the things which you have seen and of the things which I will reveal to you; ¹⁷delivering you from the people and from the Gentiles, to whom I send you, ¹⁸to open their eyes, that they may turn from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God, that they may receive remission of sins and an inheritance among those who are sanctified by faith in me.' ¹⁹"Therefore, King Agrippa, I was not disobedient to the heavenly vision, ²⁰but declared first to them of Damascus, at Jerusalem, and throughout all the country of Judea, and also to the Gentiles, that they should repent and turn to God, doing works worthy of repentance. ²¹For this reason Jews seized me in the temple and tried to kill me. ²²Having therefore obtained the help that is from God, I stand to this day testifying both to small and great, saying nothing but what the Prophets and Moses said would happen, ²³how the Messiah must suffer, and how, by the resurrection of the dead, he would be first to proclaim light both to these people and to the Gentiles." ²⁴As he thus made his defense, Festus said with a loud voice, "Paul, you are crazy! Your great learning is driving you insane!" ²⁵But he said, "I am not crazy, most excellent Festus, but boldly declare words of truth and reasonableness. ²⁶For the king knows of these things, to whom also I speak freely. For I am persuaded that none of these things is hidden from him, for this has not been done in a corner. ²⁷King Agrippa, do you believe the prophets? I know that you believe." ²⁸Agrippa said to Paul, "With a little persuasion are you trying to make me a Messianic?" ²⁹Paul said, "I pray to God, that whether with little or with much, not only you, but also all that hear me today, might become such as I am, except for these bonds." ³⁰The

king rose up with the governor and Bernice, and those who sat with them. ³¹When they had withdrawn, they spoke to one another, saying, "This man does nothing worthy of death or of bonds." ³²Agrippa said to Festus, "This man might have been set free if he had not appealed to Caesar."

27When it was determined that we should sail for Italy, they delivered Paul and certain other prisoners to a centurion named Julius, of the Augustan band. ²Embarking in a ship of Adramyttium, which was about to sail to places on the coast of Asia, we put to sea, Aristarchus, a Macedonian of Thessalonica being with us. ³The next day, we touched at Sidon. Julius treated Paul kindly and gave him permission to go to his friends and refresh himself. ⁴Putting to sea from there, we sailed under the lee of Cyprus, because the winds were contrary. ⁵When we had sailed across the sea which is off Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came to Myra, a city of Lycia. ⁶There the centurion found a ship of Alexandria sailing for Italy, and he put us on board. ⁷When we had sailed slowly many days, and had come with difficulty opposite Cnidus, the wind not allowing us further, we sailed under the lee of Crete, opposite Salmone. ⁸With difficulty sailing along it we came to a certain place called Fair Havens, near the city of Lasea. ⁹When much time had passed and the voyage was now dangerous because the Fast had now already gone by, Paul admonished them ¹⁰and said to them, "Sirs, I perceive that the voyage will be with injury and much loss, not only of the cargo and the ship, but also of our lives." ¹¹But the centurion gave more heed to the master and to the owner of the ship than to those things which were spoken by Paul. ¹²Because the haven was not suitable to winter in, the majority advised going to sea from there, if by any means they could reach Phoenix and winter there, which is a port of Crete, looking southwest and northwest. ¹³When the south wind blew softly, supposing that they had obtained their purpose, they weighed anchor and sailed along Crete, close to shore. ¹⁴But before long, a stormy wind beat down from shore, which is called Euroclydon. ^{lvii} ¹⁵When the ship was caught and couldn't face the wind, we gave way to it and were driven along. ¹⁶Running under the lee of a small island called Claudia, we were able, with difficulty, to secure the boat. ¹⁷After they had hoisted it up, they used cables to help reinforce the ship. Fearing that they would run aground on the Syrtis sand bars, they lowered the sea anchor, and so were driven along. ¹⁸As we labored exceedingly with the storm, the next day they began to throw things overboard. ¹⁹On the third day, they threw out the ship's tackle with their own hands. ²⁰When neither sun nor stars shone on us for many days, and no small storm pressed on us, all hope that we would be saved was now taken away. ²¹When they had been long without food, Paul stood up in the middle of them and said, "Sirs, you

^{lvii}Or, "a northeaster".

should have listened to me, and not have set sail from Crete and have gotten this injury and loss. ²²Now I exhort you to cheer up, for there will be no loss of life among you, but only of the ship. ²³For there stood by me this night an angel, belonging to the God whose I am and whom I serve, ²⁴saying, 'Don't be afraid, Paul. You must stand before Caesar. Behold, God has granted you all those who sail with you.' ²⁵Therefore, sirs, cheer up! For I believe God, that it will be just as it has been spoken to me. ²⁶But we must run aground on a certain island." ²⁷But when the fourteenth night had come, as we were driven back and forth in the Adriatic Sea, about midnight the sailors surmised that they were drawing near to some land. ²⁸They took soundings and found twenty fathoms. ^{lviii} After a little while, they took soundings again, and found fifteen fathoms. ^{lix} ²⁹Fearing that we would run aground on rocky ground, they let go four anchors from the stern, and wished for daylight. ³⁰As the sailors were trying to flee out of the ship and had lowered the boat into the sea, pretending that they would lay out anchors from the bow, ³¹Paul said to the centurion and to the soldiers, "Unless these stay in the ship, you can't be saved." ³²Then the soldiers cut away the ropes of the boat and let it fall off. ³³While the day was coming on, Paul begged them all to take some food, saying, "Today is the fourteenth day that you wait and continue fasting, having taken nothing. ³⁴Therefore I beg you to take some food, for this is for your safety; for not a hair will perish from any of your heads." ³⁵When he had said this and had taken bread, he gave thanks to God in the presence of all; then he broke it and began to eat. ³⁶Then they all cheered up, and they also took food. ³⁷In all, we were two hundred seventy-six souls on the ship. ³⁸When they had eaten enough, they lightened the ship, throwing out the wheat into the sea. ³⁹When it was day, they didn't recognize the land, but they noticed a certain bay with a beach, and they decided to try to drive the ship onto it. ⁴⁰Casting off the anchors, they left them in the sea, at the same time untying the rudder ropes. Hoisting up the foresail to the wind, they made for the beach. ⁴¹But coming to a place where two seas met, they ran the vessel aground. The bow struck and remained immovable, but the stern began to break up by the violence of the waves. ⁴²The soldiers' counsel was to kill the prisoners, so that none of them would swim out and escape. ⁴³But the centurion, desiring to save Paul, stopped them from their purpose, and commanded that those who could swim should throw themselves overboard first to go toward the land; ⁴⁴and the rest should follow, some on planks and some on other things from the ship. So they all escaped safely to the land.

²⁸When we had escaped, then they ^{lx} learned that the island was called Malta. ²The natives showed us uncommon kindness; for they kindled a fire and received us all, because of the present rain and because of the cold. ³But when Paul had gathered a bundle of sticks and laid them on the fire, a viper came out because of the heat and fastened on his hand. ⁴When the natives saw the creature hanging from his hand, they said to one another, "No doubt this man is a murderer, whom, though he has escaped from the sea, yet Justice has not allowed to live." ⁵However he shook off the creature into the fire, and wasn't harmed. ⁶But they expected that he would have swollen or fallen down dead suddenly, but when they watched for a long time and saw nothing bad happen to him, they changed their minds and said that he was a god. ⁷Now in the neighborhood of that place were lands belonging to the chief man of the island, named Publius, who received us and courteously entertained us for three days. ⁸The father of Publius lay sick of fever and dysentery. Paul entered in to him, prayed, and laying his hands on him, healed him. ⁹Then when this was done, the rest also who had diseases in the island came and were cured. ¹⁰They also honored us with many honors; and when we sailed, they put on board the things that we needed. ¹¹After three months, we set sail in a ship of Alexandria which had wintered in the island, whose figurehead was "The Twin Brothers." ¹²Touching at Syracuse, we stayed there three days. ¹³From there we circled around and arrived at Rhegium. After one day, a south wind sprang up, and on the second day we came to Puteoli, ^{lx} where we found brothers, ^{lxi} and were entertained to stay with them for seven days. So we came to Rome. ¹⁵From there the brothers, when they heard of us, came to meet us as far as The Market of Appius and The Three Taverns. When Paul saw them, he thanked God and took courage. ¹⁶When we entered into Rome, the centurion delivered the prisoners to the captain of the guard, but Paul was allowed to stay by himself with the soldier who guarded him. ¹⁷After three days Paul called together those who were the Jewish leaders. When they had come together, he said to them, "I, brothers, though I had done nothing against the people or the customs of our fathers, still was delivered prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans, ¹⁸who, when they had examined me, desired to set me free, because there was no cause of death in me. ¹⁹But when the Judeans spoke against it, I was constrained to appeal to Caesar, not that I had anything about which to accuse my nation. ²⁰For this cause therefore I asked to see you and to speak with you. For because of the hope of Israel I am bound with this chain." ²¹They said to him, "We neither received letters from Judea concerning you, nor did any of the brothers come here and

^{lx}NU reads "we"

^{lxi}The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{lviii}20 fathoms = 120 feet = 36.6 meters

^{lix}15 fathoms = 90 feet = 27.4 meters

report or speak any evil of you. ²²But we desire to hear from you what you think. For, as concerning this sect, it is known to us that everywhere it is spoken against.” ²³When they had appointed him a day, many people came to him at his lodging. He explained to them, testifying about God’s Kingdom, and persuading them concerning Yeshua, both from the Torah of Moses and from the Prophets, from morning until evening. ²⁴Some believed the things which were spoken, and some disbelieved. ²⁵When they didn’t agree among themselves, they departed after Paul had spoken one message: “The Holy Spirit spoke rightly through Isaiah the prophet to our fathers, ²⁶saying, ‘Go to this people and say, in hearing, you will hear, but will in no way understand. In seeing, you will see, but will in no way perceive. ²⁷For this people’s heart has grown callous. Their ears are dull of hearing. Their eyes they have closed. Lest they should see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their heart, and would turn again, then I would heal them.’ ²⁸“Be it known therefore to you that the salvation of God is sent to the nations, and they will listen.” ²⁹When he had said these words, the Jews departed, having a great dispute among themselves. ^{lxii} ³⁰Paul stayed two whole years in his own rented house and received all who were coming to him, ³¹proclaiming God’s Kingdom and teaching the things concerning the Lord Yeshua the Messiah with all boldness, without hindrance.

^{lxii}NU omits verse 29.

Romans

¹Paul, a servant of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ called to be an emissary, set apart for the Good News of God, ²which he promised before through his prophets in the holy Scriptures, ³concerning his Son, who was born of the offspring ⁱⁱ of David according to the flesh, ⁴who was declared to be the Son of God with power according to the Spirit of holiness, by the resurrection from the dead, Yeshua the Messiah our Lord, ⁵through whom we received grace and the office of emissary for obedience of faith among all the nations for his name's sake; ⁶among whom you are also called to belong to Yeshua the Messiah; ⁷to all who are in Rome, beloved of God, called to be holy ones: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁸First, I thank my God through Yeshua the Messiah for all of you, that your faith is proclaimed throughout the whole world. ⁹For God is my witness, whom I serve in my spirit in the Good News of his Son, how unceasingly I make mention of you always in my prayers, ¹⁰requesting, if by any means now at last I may be prospered by the will of God to come to you. ¹¹For I long to see you, that I may impart to you some spiritual gift, to the end that you may be established; ¹²that is, that I with you may be encouraged in you, each of us by the other's faith, both yours and mine. ¹³Now I don't desire to have you unaware, brothers, that I often planned to come to you (and was hindered so far), that I might have some fruit among you also, even as among the rest of the Gentiles. ¹⁴I am debtor both to Greeks and to foreigners, both to the wise and to the foolish. ¹⁵So as much as is in me, I am eager to proclaim the Good News to you also who are in Rome. ¹⁶For I am not ashamed of the Good News of Messiah, because it is the power of God for salvation for everyone who believes, for the Jew first, and also for the Greek. ¹⁷For in it is revealed God's righteousness from faith to faith. As it is written, "But the righteous shall live by faith." ¹⁸For the wrath of God is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men who suppress the truth in unrighteousness, ¹⁹because that which is known of God is revealed in them, for God revealed it to them. ²⁰For the invisible things of him since the creation of the world are

clearly seen, being perceived through the things that are made, even his everlasting power and divinity, that they may be without excuse. ²¹Because knowing God, they didn't glorify him as God, and didn't give thanks, but became vain in their reasoning, and their senseless heart was darkened. ²²Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools, ²³and traded the glory of the incorruptible God for the likeness of an image of corruptible man, and of birds, four-footed animals, and creeping things. ²⁴Therefore God also gave them up in the lusts of their hearts to uncleanness, that their bodies should be dishonored among themselves; ²⁵who exchanged the truth of God for a lie, and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever. Amen. ²⁶For this reason, God gave them up to vile passions. For their women changed the natural function into that which is against nature. ²⁷Likewise also the men, leaving the natural function of the woman, burned in their lust toward one another, men doing what is inappropriate with men, and receiving in themselves the due penalty of their error. ²⁸Even as they refused to have God in their knowledge, God gave them up to a reprobate mind, to do those things which are not fitting; ²⁹being filled with all unrighteousness, sexual immorality, wickedness, covetousness, malice; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, evil habits, secret slanderers, ³⁰backbiters, hateful to God, insolent, arrogant, boastful, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents, ³¹without understanding, covenant breakers, without natural affection, unforgiving, unmerciful; ³²who, knowing the ordinance of God, that those who practice such things are worthy of death, not only do the same, but also approve of those who practice them.

²Therefore you are without excuse, O man, whoever you are who judge. For in that which you judge another, you condemn yourself. For you who judge practice the same things. ²We know that the judgment of God is according to truth against those who practice such things. ³Do you think this, O man who judges those who practice such things, and do the same, that you will escape the judgment of God? ⁴Or do you despise the riches of his goodness, forbearance, and patience, not knowing that the goodness of God leads you to repentance? ⁵But according to your hardness and unrepentant heart you are treasuring

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱor, seed

up for yourself wrath in the day of wrath, revelation, and of the righteous judgment of God, ⁶who “will pay back to everyone according to their works.” ⁷to those who by perseverance in well-doing seek for glory, honor, and incorruptibility, eternal life; ⁸but to those who are self-seeking and don’t obey the truth, but obey unrighteousness, will be wrath, indignation, ⁹oppression, and anguish on every soul of man who does evil, to the Jew first, and also to the Greek. ¹⁰But glory, honor, and peace go to every man who does good, to the Jew first, and also to the Greek. ¹¹For there is no partiality with God. ¹²For as many as have sinned without the law will also perish without the law. As many as have sinned under the law will be judged by the law. ¹³For it isn’t the hearers of the law who are righteous before God, but the doers of the law will be justified ¹⁴(for when Gentiles who don’t have the law do by nature the things of the law, these, not having the law, are a law to themselves, ¹⁵in that they show the work of the law written in their hearts, their conscience testifying with them, and their thoughts among themselves accusing or else excusing them) ¹⁶in the day when God will judge the secrets of men, according to my Good News, by Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁷Indeed you bear the name of a Jew, rest on the law, glory in God, ¹⁸know his will, and approve the things that are excellent, being instructed out of the law, ¹⁹and are confident that you yourself are a guide of the blind, a light to those who are in darkness, ²⁰a corrector of the foolish, a teacher of babies, having in the law the form of knowledge and of the truth. ²¹You therefore who teach another, don’t you teach yourself? You who proclaim that a man shouldn’t steal, do you steal? ²²You who say a man shouldn’t commit adultery, do you commit adultery? You who abhor idols, do you rob temples? ²³You who glory in the law, do you dishonor God by disobeying the law? ²⁴For “the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles because of you,” just as it is written. ²⁵For circumcision indeed profits, if you are a doer of the law, but if you are a transgressor of the law, your circumcision has become uncircumcision. ²⁶If therefore the uncircumcised keep the ordinances of the law, won’t his uncircumcision be accounted as circumcision? ²⁷Won’t those who are physically uncircumcised, but fulfill the law, judge you, who with the letter and circumcision are a transgressor of the law? ²⁸For he is not a Jew who is one outwardly, neither is that circumcision which is outward in the flesh; ²⁹but he is a Jew who is one inwardly, and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit, not in the letter; whose praise is not from men, but from God.

3Then what advantage does the Jew have? Or what is the profit of circumcision? ²Much in every way! Because first of all, they were entrusted with the revelations of God. ³For what if some were without faith? Will their lack of faith nullify the faithfulness of God? ⁴May it never

be! Yes, let God be found true, but every man a liar. As it is written, “that you might be justified in your words, and might prevail when you come into judgment.” ⁵But if our unrighteousness commends the righteousness of God, what will we say? Is God unrighteous who inflicts wrath? I speak like men do. ⁶May it never be! For then how will God judge the world? ⁷For if the truth of God through my lie abounded to his glory, why am I also still judged as a sinner? ⁸Why not (as we are slanderously reported, and as some affirm that we say), “Let’s do evil, that good may come?” Those who say so are justly condemned. ⁹What then? Are we better than they? No, in no way. For we previously warned both Jews and Greeks that they are all under sin. ¹⁰As it is written, “There is no one righteous; no, not one. ¹¹There is no one who understands. There is no one who seeks after God. ¹²They have all turned away. They have together become unprofitable. There is no one who does good, no, not so much as one.” ¹³“Their throat is an open tomb. With their tongues they have used deceit.” “The poison of vipers is under their lips.” ¹⁴“Their mouth is full of cursing and bitterness.” ¹⁵“Their feet are swift to shed blood. ¹⁶Destruction and misery are in their ways. ¹⁷The way of peace, they haven’t known.” ¹⁸“There is no fear of God before their eyes.” ¹⁹Now we know that whatever things the law says, it speaks to those who are under the law, that every mouth may be closed, and all the world may be brought under the judgment of God. ²⁰Because by the works of the law, no flesh will be justified in his sight; for through the law comes the knowledge of sin. ²¹But now apart from the law, a righteousness of God has been revealed, being testified by the Torah and the Prophets; ²²even the righteousness of God through faith in Yeshua the Messiah to all and on all those who believe. For there is no distinction, ²³for all have sinned, and fall short of the glory of God; ²⁴being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Messiah Yeshua, ²⁵whom God sent to be an atoning sacrifice ⁱⁱⁱ through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness through the passing over of prior sins, in God’s forbearance; ²⁶to demonstrate his righteousness at this present time, that he might himself be just and the justifier of him who has faith in Yeshua. ²⁷Where then is the boasting? It is excluded. By what kind of law? Of works? No, but by a law of faith. ²⁸We maintain therefore that a man is justified by faith apart from the works of the law. ²⁹Or is God the God of Jews only? Isn’t he the God of Gentiles also? Yes, of Gentiles also, ³⁰since indeed there is one God who will justify the circumcised by faith and the uncircumcised through faith. ³¹Do we then nullify the law through faith? May it never be! No, we establish the law.

4What then will we say that Abraham, our forefather, has found according to the flesh? ²For if Abraham was jus-

ⁱⁱⁱor, a propitiation

tified by works, he has something to boast about, but not toward God. ³For what does the Scripture say? "Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him for righteousness." ⁴Now to him who works, the reward is not counted as grace, but as something owed. ⁵But to him who doesn't work, but believes in him who justifies the ungodly, his faith is accounted for righteousness. ⁶Even as David also pronounces blessing on the man to whom God counts righteousness apart from works: ⁷"Blessed are they whose iniquities are forgiven, whose sins are covered. ⁸Blessed is the man whom the Lord will by no means charge with sin." ⁹Is this blessing then pronounced only on the circumcised, or on the uncircumcised also? For we say that faith was accounted to Abraham for righteousness. ¹⁰How then was it counted? When he was in circumcision, or in uncircumcision? Not in circumcision, but in uncircumcision. ¹¹He received the sign of circumcision, a seal of the righteousness of the faith which he had while he was in uncircumcision, that he might be the father of all those who believe, though they might be in uncircumcision, that righteousness might also be accounted to them. ¹²He is the father of circumcision to those who not only are of the circumcision, but who also walk in the steps of that faith of our father Abraham, which he had in uncircumcision. ¹³For the promise to Abraham and to his offspring that he would be heir of the world wasn't through the law, but through the righteousness of faith. ¹⁴For if those who are of the law are heirs, faith is made void, and the promise is made of no effect. ¹⁵For the law produces wrath; for where there is no law, neither is there disobedience. ¹⁶For this cause it is of faith, that it may be according to grace, to the end that the promise may be sure to all the offspring, not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham, who is the father of us all. ¹⁷As it is written, "I have made you a father of many nations." This is in the presence of him whom he believed: God, who gives life to the dead, and calls the things that are not, as though they were. ¹⁸Against hope, Abraham in hope believed, to the end that he might become a father of many nations, according to that which had been spoken, "So will your offspring be." ¹⁹Without being weakened in faith, he didn't consider his own body, already having been worn out, (he being about a hundred years old), and the deadness of Sarah's womb. ²⁰Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn't waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, ²¹and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform. ²²Therefore it also was "credited to him for righteousness." ²³Now it was not written that it was accounted to him for his sake alone, ²⁴but for our sake also, to whom it will be accounted, who believe in him who raised Yeshua our Lord from the dead, ²⁵who was delivered up for our trespasses, and was raised for our justification.

⁵Being therefore justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Yeshua the Messiah; ²through whom we also have our access by faith into this grace in which we stand. We rejoice in hope of the glory of God. ³Not only this, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering produces perseverance; ⁴and perseverance, proven character; and proven character, hope; ⁵and hope doesn't disappoint us, because God's love has been poured into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us. ⁶For while we were yet weak, at the right time Messiah died for the ungodly. ⁷For one will hardly die for a righteous man. Yet perhaps for a good person someone would even dare to die. ⁸But God commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Messiah died for us. ⁹Much more then, being now justified by his blood, we will be saved from God's wrath through him. ¹⁰For if while we were enemies, we were reconciled to God through the death of his Son, much more, being reconciled, we will be saved by his life. ¹¹Not only so, but we also rejoice in God through our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, through whom we have now received the reconciliation. ¹²Therefore, as sin entered into the world through one man, and death through sin, so death passed to all men because all sinned. ¹³For until the law, sin was in the world; but sin is not charged when there is no law. ¹⁴Nevertheless death reigned from Adam until Moses, even over those whose sins weren't like Adam's disobedience, who is a foreshadowing of him who was to come. ¹⁵But the free gift isn't like the trespass. For if by the trespass of the one the many died, much more did the grace of God and the gift by the grace of the one man, Yeshua the Messiah, abound to the many. ¹⁶The gift is not as through one who sinned; for the judgment came by one to condemnation, but the free gift followed many trespasses to justification. ¹⁷For if by the trespass of the one, death reigned through the one; so much more will those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness reign in life through the one, Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁸So then as through one trespass, all men were condemned; even so through one act of righteousness, all men were justified to life. ¹⁹For as through the one man's disobedience many were made sinners, even so through the obedience of the one, many will be made righteous. ²⁰The law came in that the trespass might abound; but where sin abounded, grace abounded more exceedingly, ²¹that as sin reigned in death, even so grace might reign through righteousness to eternal life through Yeshua the Messiah our Lord.

⁶What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? ²May it never be! We who died to sin, how could we live in it any longer? ³Or don't you know that all of us who were immersed into Messiah Yeshua were immersed into his death? ⁴We were buried therefore with him through immersion into death, that just as Messiah

was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, so we also might walk in newness of life. ⁵For if we have become united with him in the likeness of his death, we will also be part of his resurrection; ⁶knowing this, that our old man was crucified with him, that the body of sin might be done away with, so that we would no longer be in bondage to sin. ⁷For he who has died has been freed from sin. ⁸But if we died with Messiah, we believe that we will also live with him, ⁹knowing that Messiah, being raised from the dead, dies no more. Death no longer has dominion over him! ¹⁰For the death that he died, he died to sin one time; but the life that he lives, he lives to God. ¹¹Thus consider yourselves also to be dead to sin, but alive to God in Messiah Yeshua our Lord. ¹²Therefore don't let sin reign in your mortal body, that you should obey it in its lusts. ¹³Also, do not present your members to sin as instruments of unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God as alive from the dead, and your members as instruments of righteousness to God. ¹⁴For sin will not have dominion over you, for you are not under law, but under grace. ¹⁵What then? Shall we sin because we are not under law but under grace? May it never be! ¹⁶Don't you know that when you present yourselves as servants and obey someone, you are the servants of whomever you obey, whether of sin to death, or of obedience to righteousness? ¹⁷But thanks be to God that, whereas you were bondservants of sin, you became obedient from the heart to that form of teaching to which you were delivered. ¹⁸Being made free from sin, you became bondservants of righteousness. ¹⁹I speak in human terms because of the weakness of your flesh; for as you presented your members as servants to uncleanness and to wickedness upon wickedness, even so now present your members as servants to righteousness for sanctification. ²⁰For when you were servants of sin, you were free from righteousness. ²¹What fruit then did you have at that time in the things of which you are now ashamed? For the end of those things is death. ²²But now, being made free from sin and having become servants of God, you have your fruit of sanctification and the result of eternal life. ²³For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Messiah Yeshua our Lord.

7Or don't you know, brothers ^{iv} (for I speak to men who know the law), that the law has dominion over a man for as long as he lives? ²For the woman that has a husband is bound by law to the husband while he lives, but if the husband dies, she is discharged from the law of the husband. ³So then if, while the husband lives, she is joined to another man, she would be called an adulteress. But if the husband dies, she is free from the law, so that she is no adulteress, though she is joined to another man. ⁴Therefore, my brothers, you also were made dead

to the law through the body of Messiah, that you would be joined to another, to him who was raised from the dead, that we might produce fruit to God. ⁵For when we were in the flesh, the sinful passions which were through the law worked in our members to bring out fruit to death. ⁶But now we have been discharged from the law, having died to that in which we were held; so that we serve in newness of the spirit, and not in oldness of the letter. ⁷What shall we say then? Is the law sin? May it never be! However, I wouldn't have known sin except through the law. For I wouldn't have known coveting unless the law had said, "You shall not covet." ⁸But sin, finding occasion through the commandment, produced in me all kinds of coveting. For apart from the law, sin is dead. ⁹I was alive apart from the law once, but when the commandment came, sin revived and I died. ¹⁰The commandment which was for life, this I found to be for death; ¹¹for sin, finding occasion through the commandment, deceived me, and through it killed me. ¹²Therefore the law indeed is holy, and the commandment holy, righteous, and good. ¹³Did then that which is good become death to me? May it never be! But sin, that it might be shown to be sin, was producing death in me through that which is good; that through the commandment sin might become exceedingly sinful. ¹⁴For we know that the law is spiritual, but I am fleshly, sold under sin. ¹⁵For I don't understand what I am doing. For I don't practice what I desire to do; but what I hate, that I do. ¹⁶But if what I don't desire, that I do, I consent to the law that it is good. ¹⁷So now it is no more I that do it, but sin which dwells in me. ¹⁸For I know that in me, that is, in my flesh, dwells no good thing. For desire is present with me, but I don't find it doing that which is good. ¹⁹For the good which I desire, I don't do; but the evil which I don't desire, that I practice. ²⁰But if what I don't desire, that I do, it is no more I that do it, but sin which dwells in me. ²¹I find then the law that, while I desire to do good, evil is present. ²²For I delight in God's Torah after the inward person, ²³but I see a different law in my members, warring against the law of my mind, and bringing me into captivity under the law of sin which is in my members. ²⁴What a wretched man I am! Who will deliver me out of the body of this death? ²⁵I thank God through Yeshua the Messiah, our Lord! So then with the mind, I myself serve God's Torah, but with the flesh, sin's law.

8There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Messiah Yeshua, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit. ^v ²For the law of the Spirit of life in Messiah Yeshua made me free from the law of sin and of death. ³For what the law couldn't do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God did, sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, he

^{iv}The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^vNU omits "who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit"

condemned sin in the flesh, ⁴that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit. ⁵For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit, the things of the Spirit. ⁶For the mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace; ⁷because the mind of the flesh is hostile toward God, for it is not subject to God's Torah, neither indeed can it be. ⁸Those who are in the flesh can't please God. ⁹But you are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if it is so that the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if any man doesn't have the Spirit of Messiah, he is not his. ¹⁰If Messiah is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the spirit is alive because of righteousness. ¹¹But if the Spirit of him who raised up Yeshua from the dead dwells in you, he who raised up Messiah Yeshua from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you. ¹²So then, brothers, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh. ¹³For if you live after the flesh, you must die; but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live. ¹⁴For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, these are children of God. ¹⁵For you didn't receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, "Abba! ^{vi} Father!" ¹⁶The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are children of God; ¹⁷and if children, then heirs—heirs of God and joint heirs with Messiah, if indeed we suffer with him, that we may also be glorified with him. ¹⁸For I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which will be revealed toward us. ¹⁹For the creation waits with eager expectation for the children of God to be revealed. ²⁰For the creation was subjected to vanity, not of its own will, but because of him who subjected it, in hope ²¹that the creation itself also will be delivered from the bondage of decay into the liberty of the glory of the children of God. ²²For we know that the whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now. ²³Not only so, but ourselves also, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for adoption, the redemption of our body. ²⁴For we were saved in hope, but hope that is seen is not hope. For who hopes for that which he sees? ²⁵But if we hope for that which we don't see, we wait for it with patience. ²⁶In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don't know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can't be uttered. ²⁷He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit's mind, because he makes intercession for the holy ones according to God. ²⁸We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, for those who are

called according to his purpose. ²⁹For whom he foreknew, he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers. ^{vii} ³⁰Whom he predestined, those he also called. Whom he called, those he also justified. Whom he justified, those he also glorified. ³¹What then shall we say about these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³²He who didn't spare his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how would he not also with him freely give us all things? ³³Who could bring a charge against God's chosen ones? It is God who justifies. ³⁴Who is he who condemns? It is Messiah who died, yes rather, who was raised from the dead, who is at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. ³⁵Who shall separate us from the love of Messiah? Could oppression, or anguish, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶Even as it is written, "For your sake we are killed all day long. We were accounted as sheep for the slaughter." ³⁷No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. ³⁸For I am persuaded that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor things present, nor things to come, nor powers, ³⁹nor height, nor depth, nor any other created thing will be able to separate us from God's love which is in Messiah Yeshua our Lord.

⁹I tell the truth in Messiah. I am not lying, my conscience testifying with me in the Holy Spirit ²that I have great sorrow and unceasing pain in my heart. ³For I could wish that I myself were accursed from Messiah for my brothers' sake, my relatives according to the flesh ⁴who are Israelites; whose is the adoption, the glory, the covenants, the giving of the law, the service, and the promises; ⁵of whom are the fathers, and from whom is Messiah as concerning the flesh, who is over all, God, blessed forever. Amen. ⁶But it is not as though the word of God has come to nothing. For they are not all Israel that are of Israel. ⁷Neither, because they are Abraham's offspring, are they all children. But, "your offspring will be accounted as from Isaac." ⁸That is, it is not the children of the flesh who are children of God, but the children of the promise are counted as heirs. ⁹For this is a word of promise: "At the appointed time I will come, and Sarah will have a son." ¹⁰Not only so, but Rebekah also conceived by one, by our father Isaac. ¹¹For being not yet born, neither having done anything good or bad, that the purpose of God according to election might stand, not of works, but of him who calls, ^{viii} ¹²it was said to her, "The elder will serve the younger." ¹³Even as it is written, "Jacob I loved, but Esau I hated." ¹⁴What shall we say then? Is there unrighteousness with God? May it never be! ¹⁵For he said to Moses, "I will

^{vi}Abba is an Aramaic word for "Father" or "Daddy", which can be used affectionately and respectfully in prayer to our Father in heaven.

^{vii}The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{viii}NU puts the phrase "not of works, but of him who calls" at the beginning of verse 12 instead of the end of verse 11.

have mercy on whom I have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I have compassion.” ¹⁶So then it is not of him who wills, nor of him who runs, but of God who has mercy. ¹⁷For the Scripture says to Pharaoh, “For this very purpose I caused you to be raised up, that I might show in you my power, and that my name might be proclaimed in all the earth.” ¹⁸So then, he has mercy on whom he desires, and he hardens whom he desires. ¹⁹You will say then to me, “Why does he still find fault? For who withstands his will?” ²⁰But indeed, O man, who are you to reply against God? Will the thing formed ask him who formed it, “Why did you make me like this?” ²¹Or hasn’t the potter a right over the clay, from the same lump to make one part a vessel for honor, and another for dishonor? ²²What if God, willing to show his wrath and to make his power known, endured with much patience vessels of wrath prepared for destruction, ²³and that he might make known the riches of his glory on vessels of mercy, which he prepared beforehand for glory— ²⁴us, whom he also called, not from the Jews only, but also from the Gentiles? ²⁵As he says also in Hosea, “I will call them ‘my people,’ which were not my people; and her ‘beloved,’ who was not beloved.” ²⁶“It will be that in the place where it was said to them, ‘You are not my people,’ there they will be called ‘children of the living God.’” ²⁷Isaiah cries concerning Israel, “If the number of the children of Israel are as the sand of the sea, it is the remnant who will be saved; ²⁸for he will finish the work and cut it short in righteousness, because the Lord will make a short work upon the earth.” ²⁹As Isaiah has said before, “Unless the Lord of Hosts ^{ix} had left us a seed, we would have become like Sodom, and would have been made like Gomorrah.” ³⁰What shall we say then? That the Gentiles, who didn’t follow after righteousness, attained to righteousness, even the righteousness which is of faith; ³¹but Israel, following after a law of righteousness, didn’t arrive at the law of righteousness. ³²Why? Because they didn’t seek it by faith, but as it were by works of the law. They stumbled over the stumbling stone, ³³even as it is written, “Behold, ^x I lay in Zion a stumbling stone and a rock of offense; and no one who believes in him will be disappointed.”

¹⁰Brothers, my heart’s desire and my prayer to God is for Israel, that they may be saved. ²For I testify about them that they have a zeal for God, but not according to knowledge. ³For being ignorant of God’s righteousness, and seeking to establish their own righteousness, they didn’t subject themselves to the righteousness of God. ⁴For Messiah is the fulfillment ^{xi} of the law for righteousness to everyone who believes. ⁵For Moses writes about the right-

eousness of the law, “The one who does them will live by them.” ⁶But the righteousness which is of faith says this, “Don’t say in your heart, ‘Who will ascend into heaven?’ (that is, to bring Messiah down); ⁷or, ‘Who will descend into the abyss?’ (that is, to bring Messiah up from the dead.)” ⁸But what does it say? “The word is near you, in your mouth and in your heart;” that is, the word of faith which we proclaim: ⁹that if you will confess with your mouth that Yeshua is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. ¹⁰For with the heart one believes resulting in righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made resulting in salvation. ¹¹For the Scripture says, “Whoever believes in him will not be disappointed.” ¹²For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek; for the same Lord is Lord of all, and is rich to all who call on him. ¹³For, “Whoever will call on the name of the Lord will be saved.” ¹⁴How then will they call on him in whom they have not believed? How will they believe in him whom they have not heard? How will they hear without a proclaimer? ¹⁵And how will they proclaim unless they are sent? As it is written: “How beautiful are the feet of those who proclaim the Good News of peace, who bring glad tidings of good things!” ¹⁶But they didn’t all listen to the glad news. For Isaiah says, “Lord, who has believed our report?” ¹⁷So faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God. ¹⁸But I say, didn’t they hear? Yes, most certainly, “Their sound went out into all the earth, their words to the ends of the world.” ¹⁹But I ask, didn’t Israel know? First Moses says, “I will provoke you to jealousy with that which is no nation. I will make you angry with a nation void of understanding.” ²⁰Isaiah is very bold and says, “I was found by those who didn’t seek me. I was revealed to those who didn’t ask for me.” ²¹But about Israel he says, “All day long I stretched out my hands to a disobedient and contrary people.”

¹¹I ask then, did God reject his people? May it never be! For I also am an Israelite, a descendant of Abraham, of the tribe of Benjamin. ²God didn’t reject his people, whom he foreknew. Or don’t you know what the Scripture says about Elijah? How he pleads with God against Israel: ³“Lord, they have killed your prophets. They have broken down your altars. I am left alone, and they seek my life.” ⁴But how does God answer him? “I have reserved for myself seven thousand men who have not bowed the knee to Baal.” ⁵Even so too at this present time also there is a remnant according to the election of grace. ⁶And if by grace, then it is no longer of works; otherwise grace is no longer grace. But if it is of works, it is no longer grace; otherwise work is no longer work. ⁷What then? That which Israel seeks for, that he didn’t obtain, but the chosen ones obtained it, and the rest were hardened. ⁸According as it is written, “God gave them a spirit of stupor, eyes that they should not see, and ears that they should not

^{ix}Greek: Sabaoth (for Hebrew: Tze’va’ot)

^x“Behold”, from “ ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{xi}or, completion, or end

hear, to this very day.” ⁹David says, “Let their table be made a snare, a trap, a stumbling block, and a retribution to them. ¹⁰Let their eyes be darkened, that they may not see. Always keep their backs bent.” ¹¹I ask then, did they stumble that they might fall? May it never be! But by their fall salvation has come to the Gentiles, to provoke them to jealousy. ¹²Now if their fall is the riches of the world, and their loss the riches of the Gentiles, how much more their fullness! ¹³For I speak to you who are Gentiles. Since then as I am an emissary to Gentiles, I glorify my ministry, ¹⁴if by any means I may provoke to jealousy those who are my flesh, and may save some of them. ¹⁵For if the rejection of them is the reconciling of the world, what would their acceptance be, but life from the dead? ¹⁶If the first fruit is holy, so is the lump. If the root is holy, so are the branches. ¹⁷But if some of the branches were broken off, and you, being a wild olive, were grafted in among them and became partaker with them of the root and of the richness of the olive tree, ¹⁸don’t boast over the branches. But if you boast, remember that it is not you who support the root, but the root supports you. ¹⁹You will say then, “Branches were broken off, that I might be grafted in.” ²⁰True; by their unbelief they were broken off, and you stand by your faith. Don’t be conceited, but fear; ²¹for if God didn’t spare the natural branches, neither will he spare you. ²²See then the goodness and severity of God. Toward those who fell, severity; but toward you, goodness, if you continue in his goodness; otherwise you also will be cut off. ²³They also, if they don’t continue in their unbelief, will be grafted in, for God is able to graft them in again. ²⁴For if you were cut out of that which is by nature a wild olive tree, and were grafted contrary to nature into a good olive tree, how much more will these, which are the natural branches, be grafted into their own olive tree? ²⁵For I don’t desire you to be ignorant, brothers, ^{xii} of this mystery, so that you won’t be wise in your own conceits, that a partial hardening has happened to Israel, until the fullness of the Gentiles has come in, ²⁶and so all Israel will be saved. Even as it is written, “There will come out of Zion the Deliverer, and he will turn away ungodliness from Jacob. ²⁷This is my covenant with them, when I will take away their sins.” ²⁸Concerning the Good News, they are enemies for your sake. But concerning the election, they are beloved for the fathers’ sake. ²⁹For the gifts and the calling of God are irrevocable. ³⁰For as you in time past were disobedient to God, but now have obtained mercy by their disobedience, ³¹even so these also have now been disobedient, that by the mercy shown to you they may also obtain mercy. ³²For God has bound all to disobedience, that he might have mercy on all. ³³Oh the depth of the riches both of the wisdom and the knowledge of God! How unsearchable are his judgments, and his ways past tracing

^{xii}The word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

out! ³⁴“For who has known the mind of the Lord? Or who has been his counselor?” ³⁵“Or who has first given to him, and it will be repaid to him again?” ³⁶For of him and through him and to him are all things. To him be the glory for ever! Amen.

12Therefore I urge you, brothers, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your spiritual service. ²Don’t be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may prove what is the good, well-pleasing, and perfect will of God. ³For I say through the grace that was given me, to everyone who is among you, not to think of yourself more highly than you ought to think; but to think reasonably, as God has apportioned to each person a measure of faith. ⁴For even as we have many members in one body, and all the members don’t have the same function, ⁵so we, who are many, are one body in Messiah, and individually members of one another, ⁶having gifts differing according to the grace that was given to us: if prophecy, let’s prophesy according to the proportion of our faith; ⁷or service, let’s give ourselves to service; or he who teaches, to his teaching; ⁸or he who exhorts, to his exhorting; he who gives, let him do it with generosity; he who rules, with diligence; he who shows mercy, with cheerfulness. ⁹Let love be without hypocrisy. Abhor that which is evil. Cling to that which is good. ¹⁰In love of the brothers be tenderly affectionate to one another; in honor prefer one another, ¹¹not lagging in diligence, fervent in spirit, serving the Lord, ¹²rejoicing in hope, enduring in troubles, continuing steadfastly in prayer, ¹³contributing to the needs of the holy ones, and given to hospitality. ¹⁴Bless those who persecute you; bless, and don’t curse. ¹⁵Rejoice with those who rejoice. Weep with those who weep. ¹⁶Be of the same mind one toward another. Don’t set your mind on high things, but associate with the humble. Don’t be wise in your own conceits. ¹⁷Repay no one evil for evil. Respect what is honorable in the sight of all men. ¹⁸If it is possible, as much as it is up to you, be at peace with all men. ¹⁹Don’t seek revenge yourselves, beloved, but give place to God’s wrath. For it is written, “Vengeance belongs to me; I will repay, says the Lord.” ²⁰Therefore “If your enemy is hungry, feed him. If he is thirsty, give him a drink; for in doing so, you will heap coals of fire on his head.” ²¹Don’t be overcome by evil, but overcome evil with good.

13Let every soul be in subjection to the higher authorities, for there is no authority except from God, and those who exist are ordained by God. ²Therefore he who resists the authority withstands the ordinance of God; and those who withstand will receive to themselves judgment. ³For rulers are not a terror to the good work, but to the evil. Do you desire to have no fear of the authority? Do that

which is good, and you will have praise from the authority, ⁴for he is a servant of God to you for good. But if you do that which is evil, be afraid, for he doesn't bear the sword in vain; for he is a servant of God, an avenger for wrath to him who does evil. ⁵Therefore you need to be in subjection, not only because of the wrath, but also for conscience' sake. ⁶For this reason you also pay taxes, for they are servants of God's service, continually doing this very thing. ⁷Therefore give everyone what you owe: if you owe taxes, pay taxes; if customs, then customs; if respect, then respect; if honor, then honor. ⁸Owe no one anything, except to love one another; for he who loves his neighbor has fulfilled the law. ⁹For the commandments, "You shall not commit adultery," "You shall not murder," "You shall not steal," ^{xiii} "You shall not covet," and whatever other commandments there are, are all summed up in this saying, namely, "You shall love your neighbor as yourself." ¹⁰Love doesn't harm a neighbor. Love therefore is the fulfillment of the law. ¹¹Do this, knowing the time, that it is already time for you to awaken out of sleep, for salvation is now nearer to us than when we first believed. ¹²The night is far gone, and the day is near. Let's therefore throw off the deeds of darkness, and let's put on the armor of light. ¹³Let's walk properly, as in the day; not in reveling and drunkenness, not in sexual promiscuity and lustful acts, and not in strife and jealousy. ¹⁴But put on the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, and make no provision for the flesh, for its lusts.

14Now accept one who is weak in faith, but not for disputes over opinions. ²One man has faith to eat all things, but he who is weak eats only vegetables. ³Don't let him who eats despise him who doesn't eat. Don't let him who doesn't eat judge him who eats, for God has accepted him. ⁴Who are you who judge another's servant? To his own lord he stands or falls. Yes, he will be made to stand, for God has power to make him stand. ⁵One man esteems one day as more important. Another esteems every day alike. Let each man be fully assured in his own mind. ⁶He who observes the day, observes it to the Lord; and he who does not observe the day, to the Lord he does not observe it. He who eats, eats to the Lord, for he gives God thanks. He who doesn't eat, to the Lord he doesn't eat, and gives God thanks. ⁷For none of us lives to himself, and none dies to himself. ⁸For if we live, we live to the Lord. Or if we die, we die to the Lord. If therefore we live or die, we are the Lord's. ⁹For to this end Messiah died, rose, and lived again, that he might be Lord of both the dead and the living. ¹⁰But you, why do you judge your brother? Or you again, why do you despise your brother? For we will all stand before the judgment seat of Messiah. ¹¹For it is written, "'As I live,' says the Lord, 'to me every knee will bow. Every tongue will confess to God.'" ¹²So then each

one of us will give account of himself to God. ¹³Therefore let's not judge one another any more, but judge this rather, that no man put a stumbling block in his brother's way, or an occasion for falling. ¹⁴I know and am persuaded in the Lord Yeshua that nothing is unclean of itself; except that to him who considers anything to be unclean, to him it is unclean. ¹⁵Yet if because of food your brother is grieved, you walk no longer in love. Don't destroy with your food him for whom Messiah died. ¹⁶Then don't let your good be slandered, ¹⁷for God's Kingdom is not eating and drinking, but righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit. ¹⁸For he who serves Messiah in these things is acceptable to God and approved by men. ¹⁹So then, let's follow after things which make for peace, and things by which we may build one another up. ²⁰Don't overthrow God's work for food's sake. All things indeed are clean, however it is evil for that man who creates a stumbling block by eating. ²¹It is good to not eat meat, drink wine, nor do anything by which your brother stumbles, is offended, or is made weak. ²²Do you have faith? Have it to yourself before God. Happy is he who doesn't judge himself in that which he approves. ²³But he who doubts is condemned if he eats, because it isn't of faith; and whatever is not of faith is sin. ²⁴Now to him who is able to establish you according to my Good News and the proclaiming of Yeshua the Messiah, according to the revelation of the mystery which has been kept secret through long ages, ²⁵but now is revealed, and by the Scriptures of the prophets, according to the commandment of the eternal God, is made known for obedience of faith to all the nations; ²⁶to the only wise God, through Yeshua the Messiah, to whom be the glory forever! Amen. ^{xiv}

15Now we who are strong ought to bear the weaknesses of the weak, and not to please ourselves. ²Let each one of us please his neighbor for that which is good, to be building him up. ³For even Messiah didn't please himself. But, as it is written, "The reproaches of those who reproached you fell on me." ⁴For whatever things were written before were written for our learning, that through perseverance and through encouragement of the Scriptures we might have hope. ⁵Now the God of perseverance and of encouragement grant you to be of the same mind with one another according to Messiah Yeshua, ⁶that with one accord you may with one mouth glorify the God and Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁷Therefore accept one another, even as Messiah also accepted you, ^{xv} to the glory of God. ⁸Now I say that Messiah has been made a servant of the circumcision for the truth of God, that he might confirm the promises given to the fathers, ⁹and that the Gentiles might glorify God for his mercy. As it is written, "Therefore I will give praise to you among the Gentiles and sing to your name." ¹⁰Again he says, "Rejoice, you Gentiles,

^{xiii}TR adds "You shall not give false testimony,"

^{xiv}TR places verses 24-26 after

^{xv}TR reads "us" instead of "you"

with his people.” ¹¹Again, “Praise the Lord, all you Gentiles! Let all the peoples praise him.” ¹²Again, Isaiah says, “There will be the root of Jesse, he who arises to rule over the Gentiles; in him the Gentiles will hope.” ¹³Now may the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, that you may abound in hope in the power of the Holy Spirit. ¹⁴I myself am also persuaded about you, my brothers, ^{xvi} that you yourselves are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish others. ¹⁵But I write the more boldly to you in part as reminding you, because of the grace that was given to me by God, ¹⁶that I should be a servant of Messiah Yeshua to the Gentiles, serving as a priest of the Good News of God, that the offering up of the Gentiles might be made acceptable, sanctified by the Holy Spirit. ¹⁷I have therefore my boasting in Messiah Yeshua in things pertaining to God. ¹⁸For I will not dare to speak of any things except those which Messiah worked through me for the obedience of the Gentiles, by word and deed, ¹⁹in the power of signs and wonders, in the power of God’s Spirit; so that from Jerusalem and around as far as to Illyricum, I have fully preached the Good News of Messiah; ²⁰yes, making it my aim to proclaim the Good News, not where Messiah was already named, that I might not build on another’s foundation. ²¹But, as it is written, “They will see, to whom no news of him came. They who haven’t heard will understand.” ²²Therefore also I was hindered these many times from coming to you, ²³but now, no longer having any place in these regions, and having these many years a longing to come to you, ²⁴whenever I travel to Spain, I will come to you. For I hope to see you on my journey, and to be helped on my way there by you, if first I may enjoy your company for a while. ²⁵But now, I say, I am going to Jerusalem, serving the holy ones. ²⁶For it has been the good pleasure of Macedonia and Achaia to make a certain contribution for the poor among the holy ones who are at Jerusalem. ²⁷Yes, it has been their good pleasure, and they are their debtors. For if the Gentiles have been made partakers of their spiritual things, they owe it to them also to serve them in material things. ²⁸When therefore I have accomplished this, and have sealed to them this fruit, I will go on by way of you to Spain. ²⁹I know that when I come to you, I will come in the fullness of the blessing of the Good News of Messiah. ³⁰Now I beg you, brothers, by our Lord Yeshua the Messiah and by the love of the Spirit, that you strive together with me in your prayers to God for me, ³¹that I may be delivered from those who are disobedient in Judea, and that my service which I have for Jerusalem may be acceptable to the holy ones, ³²that I may come to you in joy through the will of God, and together with you, find rest. ³³Now the God of peace be with you all. Amen.

^{xvi}The word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

¹⁶I commend to you Phoebe, our sister, who is a servant ^{xvii} of the assembly that is at Cenchreae, ²that you receive her in the Lord in a way worthy of the holy ones, and that you assist her in whatever matter she may need from you, for she herself also has been a helper of many, and of my own self. ³Greet Prisca and Aquila, my fellow workers in Messiah Yeshua, ⁴who risked their own necks for my life, to whom not only I give thanks, but also all the assemblies of the Gentiles. ⁵Greet the assembly that is in their house. Greet Epānetus, my beloved, who is the first fruits of Achaia to Messiah. ⁶Greet Miriam, who labored much for us. ⁷Greet Andronicus and Junia, my relatives and my fellow prisoners, who are notable among the emissaries, who were also in Messiah before me. ⁸Greet Amplias, my beloved in the Lord. ⁹Greet Urbanus, our fellow worker in Messiah, and Stachys, my beloved. ¹⁰Greet Apelles, the approved in Messiah. Greet those who are of the household of Aristobulus. ¹¹Greet Herodion, my kinsman. Greet them of the household of Narcissus, who are in the Lord. ¹²Greet Tryphaena and Tryphosa, who labor in the Lord. Greet Persis, the beloved, who labored much in the Lord. ¹³Greet Rufus, the chosen in the Lord, and his mother and mine. ¹⁴Greet Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermes, Patrobas, Hermas, and the brothers ^{xviii} who are with them. ¹⁵Greet Philologus and Julia, Nereus and his sister, and Olympas, and all the holy ones who are with them. ¹⁶Greet one another with a holy kiss. The assemblies of Messiah greet you. ¹⁷Now I beg you, brothers, look out for those who are causing the divisions and occasions of stumbling, contrary to the doctrine which you learned, and turn away from them. ¹⁸For those who are such don’t serve our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, but their own belly; and by their smooth and flattering speech they deceive the hearts of the innocent. ¹⁹For your obedience has become known to all. I rejoice therefore over you. But I desire to have you wise in that which is good, but innocent in that which is evil. ²⁰And the God of peace will quickly crush Satan under your feet. The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you. ²¹Timothy, my fellow worker, greets you, as do Lucius, Jason, and Sosipater, my relatives. ²²I, Tertius, who write the letter, greet you in the Lord. ²³Gaius, my host and host of the whole assembly, greets you. Erastus, the treasurer of the city, greets you, as does Quartus, the brother. ²⁴The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you all! Amen. ²⁵^{xix}

^{xvii}or, deacon

^{xviii}The word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

^{xix}TR places

1 Corinthians

¹Paul, called to be an emissary of Yeshua the Messiah ⁱ through the will of God, and our brother Sosthenes, ²to the assembly of God which is at Corinth—those who are sanctified in Messiah Yeshua, called holy ones, with all who call on the name of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah in every place, both theirs and ours: ³Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁴I always thank my God concerning you for the grace of God which was given you in Messiah Yeshua, ⁵that in everything you were enriched in him, in all speech and all knowledge—⁶even as the testimony of Messiah was confirmed in you—⁷so that you come behind in no gift, waiting for the revelation of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ⁸who will also confirm you until the end, blameless in the day of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁹God is faithful, through whom you were called into the fellowship of his Son, Yeshua the Messiah our Lord. ¹⁰Now I beg you, brothers, ⁱⁱ through the name of our Lord, Yeshua the Messiah, that you all speak the same thing, and that there be no divisions among you, but that you be perfected together in the same mind and in the same judgment. ¹¹For it has been reported to me concerning you, my brothers, by those who are from Chloe's household, that there are contentions among you. ¹²Now I mean this, that each one of you says, "I follow Paul," "I follow Apollos," "I follow Kefa," and, "I follow Messiah." ¹³Is Messiah divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Or were you immersed into the name of Paul? ¹⁴I thank God that I immersed none of you except Crispus and Gaius, ¹⁵so that no one should say that I had immersed you into my own name. ¹⁶(I also immersed the household of Stephanas; besides them, I don't know whether I immersed any other.) ¹⁷For Messiah sent me not to immerse, but to proclaim the Good News—not in wisdom of words, so that the cross of Messiah wouldn't be made void. ¹⁸For the word of the cross is foolishness to those who are dying, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God. ¹⁹For it is written, "I will destroy the wisdom of the wise. I will bring the discernment of the discerning to nothing." ²⁰Where is the wise? Where is the scribe? Where is the debater of this

age? Hasn't God made foolish the wisdom of this world? ²¹For seeing that in the wisdom of God, the world through its wisdom didn't know God, it was God's good pleasure through the foolishness of the proclaiming to save those who believe. ²²For Jews ask for signs, Greeks seek after wisdom, ²³but we proclaim Messiah crucified, a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Greeks, ²⁴but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Messiah is the power of God and the wisdom of God; ²⁵because the foolishness of God is wiser than men, and the weakness of God is stronger than men. ²⁶For you see your calling, brothers, that not many are wise according to the flesh, not many mighty, and not many noble; ²⁷but God chose the foolish things of the world that he might put to shame those who are wise. God chose the weak things of the world that he might put to shame the things that are strong. ²⁸God chose the lowly things of the world, and the things that are despised, and the things that don't exist, that he might bring to nothing the things that exist, ²⁹that no flesh should boast before God. ³⁰Because of him, you are in Messiah Yeshua, who was made to us wisdom from God, and righteousness and sanctification, and redemption, ³¹that, as it is written, "He who boasts, let him boast in the Lord."

²When I came to you, brothers, I didn't come with excellence of speech or of wisdom, proclaiming to you the testimony of God. ²For I determined not to know anything among you except Yeshua the Messiah and him crucified. ³I was with you in weakness, in fear, and in much trembling. ⁴My speech and my proclaiming were not in persuasive words of human wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power, ⁵that your faith wouldn't stand in the wisdom of men, but in the power of God. ⁶We speak wisdom, however, among those who are full grown, yet a wisdom not of this world nor of the rulers of this world who are coming to nothing. ⁷But we speak God's wisdom in a mystery, the wisdom that has been hidden, which God foreordained before the worlds for our glory, ⁸which none of the rulers of this world has known. For had they known it, they wouldn't have crucified the Lord of glory. ⁹But as it is written, "Things which an eye didn't see, and an ear didn't hear, which didn't enter into the heart of man, these God has prepared for those who love him." ¹⁰But to

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

us, God revealed them through the Spirit. For the Spirit searches all things, yes, the deep things of God. ¹¹For who among men knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so, no one knows the things of God except God's Spirit. ¹²But we received not the spirit of the world, but the Spirit which is from God, that we might know the things that were freely given to us by God. ¹³We also speak these things, not in words which man's wisdom teaches but which the Holy Spirit teaches, comparing spiritual things with spiritual things. ¹⁴Now the natural man doesn't receive the things of God's Spirit, for they are foolishness to him; and he can't know them, because they are spiritually discerned. ¹⁵But he who is spiritual discerns all things, and he himself is to be judged by no one. ¹⁶"For who has known the mind of the Lord that he should instruct him?" But we have Messiah's mind.

³Brothers, I couldn't speak to you as to spiritual, but as to fleshly, as to babies in Messiah. ²I fed you with milk, not with solid food, for you weren't yet ready. Indeed, you aren't ready even now, ³for you are still fleshly. For insofar as there is jealousy, strife, and factions among you, aren't you fleshly, and don't you walk in the ways of men? ⁴For when one says, "I follow Paul," and another, "I follow Apollos," aren't you fleshly? ⁵Who then is Apollos, and who is Paul, but servants through whom you believed, and each as the Lord gave to him? ⁶I planted. Apollos watered. But God gave the increase. ⁷So then neither he who plants is anything, nor he who waters, but God who gives the increase. ⁸Now he who plants and he who waters are the same, but each will receive his own reward according to his own labor. ⁹For we are God's fellow workers. You are God's farming, God's building. ¹⁰According to the grace of God which was given to me, as a wise master builder I laid a foundation, and another builds on it. But let each man be careful how he builds on it. ¹¹For no one can lay any other foundation than that which has been laid, which is Yeshua the Messiah. ¹²But if anyone builds on the foundation with gold, silver, costly stones, wood, hay, or straw, ¹³each man's work will be revealed. For the Day will declare it, because it is revealed in fire; and the fire itself will test what sort of work each man's work is. ¹⁴If any man's work remains which he built on it, he will receive a reward. ¹⁵If any man's work is burned, he will suffer loss, but he himself will be saved, but as through fire. ¹⁶Don't you know that you are God's temple and that God's Spirit lives in you? ¹⁷If anyone destroys God's temple, God will destroy him; for God's temple is holy, which you are. ¹⁸Let no one deceive himself. If anyone thinks that he is wise among you in this world, let him become a fool that he may become wise. ¹⁹For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God. For it is written, "He has taken the wise in their craftiness." ²⁰And again, "The

Lord knows the reasoning of the wise, that it is worthless." ²¹Therefore let no one boast in men. For all things are yours, ²²whether Paul, or Apollos, or Kefa, or the world, or life, or death, or things present, or things to come. All are yours, ²³and you are Messiah's, and Messiah is God's.

⁴So let a man think of us as Messiah's servants and stewards of God's mysteries. ²Here, moreover, it is required of stewards that they be found faithful. ³But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged by you, or by a human court. Yes, I don't even judge my own self. ⁴For I know nothing against myself. Yet I am not justified by this, but he who judges me is the Lord. ⁵Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord comes, who will both bring to light the hidden things of darkness and reveal the counsels of the hearts. Then each man will get his praise from God. ⁶Now these things, brothers, I have in a figure transferred to myself and Apollos for your sakes, that in us you might learn not to think beyond the things which are written, that none of you be puffed up against one another. ⁷For who makes you different? And what do you have that you didn't receive? But if you did receive it, why do you boast as if you had not received it? ⁸You are already filled. You have already become rich. You have come to reign without us. Yes, and I wish that you did reign, that we also might reign with you! ⁹For I think that God has displayed us, the emissaries, last of all, like men sentenced to death. For we are made a spectacle to the world, both to angels and men. ¹⁰We are fools for Messiah's sake, but you are wise in Messiah. We are weak, but you are strong. You have honor, but we have dishonor. ¹¹Even to this present hour we hunger, thirst, are naked, are beaten, and have no certain dwelling place. ¹²We toil, working with our own hands. When people curse us, we bless. Being persecuted, we endure. ¹³Being defamed, we entreat. We are made as the filth of the world, the dirt wiped off by all, even until now. ¹⁴I don't write these things to shame you, but to admonish you as my beloved children. ¹⁵For though you have ten thousand tutors in Messiah, you don't have many fathers. For in Messiah Yeshua, I became your father through the Good News. ¹⁶I beg you therefore, be imitators of me. ¹⁷Because of this I have sent Timothy to you, who is my beloved and faithful child in the Lord, who will remind you of my ways which are in Messiah, even as I teach everywhere in every assembly. ¹⁸Now some are puffed up, as though I were not coming to you. ¹⁹But I will come to you shortly, if the Lord is willing. And I will know, not the word of those who are puffed up, but the power. ²⁰For God's Kingdom is not in word, but in power. ²¹What do you want? Shall I come to you with a rod, or in love and a spirit of gentleness?

⁵It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even

named among the Gentiles, that one has his father's wife. ²You are arrogant, and didn't mourn instead, that he who had done this deed might be removed from among you. ³For I most certainly, as being absent in body but present in spirit, have already, as though I were present, judged him who has done this thing. ⁴In the name of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, when you are gathered together with my spirit with the power of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ⁵you are to deliver such a one to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Yeshua. ⁶Your boasting is not good. Don't you know that a little yeast leavens the whole lump? ⁷Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump, even as you are unleavened. For indeed Messiah, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place. ⁸Therefore let's keep the feast, not with old yeast, neither with the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth. ⁹I wrote to you in my letter to have no company with sexual sinners; ¹⁰yet not at all meaning with the sexual sinners of this world, or with the covetous and extortionists, or with idolaters, for then you would have to leave the world. ¹¹But as it is, I wrote to you not to associate with anyone who is called a brother who is a sexual sinner, or covetous, or an idolater, or a slanderer, or a drunkard, or an extortionist. Don't even eat with such a person. ¹²For what do I have to do with also judging those who are outside? Don't you judge those who are within? ¹³But those who are outside, God judges. "Put away the wicked man from among yourselves."

⁶Dare any of you, having a matter against his neighbor, go to law before the unrighteous, and not before the holy ones? ²Don't you know that the holy ones will judge the world? And if the world is judged by you, are you unworthy to judge the smallest matters? ³Don't you know that we will judge angels? How much more, things that pertain to this life? ⁴If then you have to judge things pertaining to this life, do you set them to judge who are of no account in the assembly? ⁵I say this to move you to shame. Isn't there even one wise man among you who would be able to decide between his brothers? ⁶But brother goes to law with brother, and that before unbelievers! ⁷Therefore it is already altogether a defect in you that you have lawsuits one with another. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be defrauded? ⁸No, but you yourselves do wrong and defraud, and that against your brothers. ⁹Or don't you know that the unrighteous will not inherit God's Kingdom? Don't be deceived. Neither the sexually immoral, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor male prostitutes, nor homosexuals, ¹⁰nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor slanderers, nor extortionists, will inherit God's Kingdom. ¹¹Some of you were such, but you were washed. You were sanctified. You were justified in the name of the Lord Yeshua, and in the Spirit of our God. ¹²"All things are law-

ful for me," but not all things are expedient. "All things are lawful for me," but I will not be brought under the power of anything. ¹³"Foods for the belly, and the belly for foods," but God will bring to nothing both it and them. But the body is not for sexual immorality, but for the Lord, and the Lord for the body. ¹⁴Now God raised up the Lord, and will also raise us up by his power. ¹⁵Don't you know that your bodies are members of Messiah? Shall I then take the members of Messiah and make them members of a prostitute? May it never be! ¹⁶Or don't you know that he who is joined to a prostitute is one body? For, "The two", he says, "will become one flesh." ¹⁷But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit. ¹⁸Flee sexual immorality! "Every sin that a man does is outside the body," but he who commits sexual immorality sins against his own body. ¹⁹Or don't you know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have from God? You are not your own, ²⁰for you were bought with a price. Therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's.

⁷Now concerning the things about which you wrote to me: it is good for a man not to touch a woman. ²But, because of sexual immoralities, let each man have his own wife, and let each woman have her own husband. ³Let the husband give his wife the affection owed her, ⁱⁱⁱ and likewise also the wife her husband. ⁴The wife doesn't have authority over her own body, but the husband does. Likewise also the husband doesn't have authority over his own body, but the wife does. ⁵Don't deprive one another, unless it is by consent for a season, that you may give yourselves to fasting and prayer, and may be together again, that Satan doesn't tempt you because of your lack of self-control. ⁶But this I say by way of concession, not of commandment. ⁷Yet I wish that all men were like me. However, each man has his own gift from God, one of this kind, and another of that kind. ⁸But I say to the unmarried and to widows, it is good for them if they remain even as I am. ⁹But if they don't have self-control, let them marry. For it's better to marry than to burn with passion. ¹⁰But to the married I command—not I, but the Lord—that the wife not leave her husband ¹¹(but if she departs, let her remain unmarried, or else be reconciled to her husband), and that the husband not leave his wife. ¹²But to the rest I—not the Lord—say, if any brother has an unbelieving wife, and she is content to live with him, let him not leave her. ¹³The woman who has an unbelieving husband, and he is content to live with her, let her not leave her husband. ¹⁴For the unbelieving husband is sanctified in the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified in the husband. Otherwise your children would be unclean, but now they are holy. ¹⁵Yet if the unbeliever departs, let there be sep-

ⁱⁱⁱNU and TR have "what is owed her" instead of "the affection owed her".

aration. The brother or the sister is not under bondage in such cases, but God has called us in peace. ¹⁶For how do you know, wife, whether you will save your husband? Or how do you know, husband, whether you will save your wife? ¹⁷Only, as the Lord has distributed to each man, as God has called each, so let him walk. So I command in all the assemblies. ¹⁸Was anyone called having been circumcised? Let him not become uncircumcised. Has anyone been called in uncircumcision? Let him not be circumcised. ¹⁹Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but what matters is keeping God's commandments. ²⁰Let each man stay in that calling in which he was called. ²¹Were you called being a bondservant? Don't let that bother you, but if you get an opportunity to become free, use it. ²²For he who was called in the Lord being a bondservant is the Lord's free man. Likewise he who was called being free is Messiah's bondservant. ²³You were bought with a price. Don't become bondservants of men. ²⁴Brothers, let each man, in whatever condition he was called, stay in that condition with God. ²⁵Now concerning virgins, I have no commandment from the Lord, but I give my judgment as one who has obtained mercy from the Lord to be trustworthy. ²⁶Therefore I think that because of the distress that is on us, it's good for a man to remain as he is. ²⁷Are you bound to a wife? Don't seek to be freed. Are you free from a wife? Don't seek a wife. ²⁸But if you marry, you have not sinned. If a virgin marries, she has not sinned. Yet such will have oppression in the flesh, and I want to spare you. ²⁹But I say this, brothers: the time is short. From now on, both those who have wives may be as though they had none; ³⁰and those who weep, as though they didn't weep; and those who rejoice, as though they didn't rejoice; and those who buy, as though they didn't possess; ³¹and those who use the world, as not using it to the fullest. For the mode of this world passes away. ³²But I desire to have you to be free from cares. He who is unmarried is concerned for the things of the Lord, how he may please the Lord; ³³but he who is married is concerned about the things of the world, how he may please his wife. ³⁴There is also a difference between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman cares about the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit. But she who is married cares about the things of the world—how she may please her husband. ³⁵This I say for your own benefit, not that I may ensnare you, but for that which is appropriate, and that you may attend to the Lord without distraction. ³⁶But if any man thinks that he is behaving inappropriately toward his virgin, if she is past the flower of her age, and if need so requires, let him do what he desires. He doesn't sin. Let them marry. ³⁷But he who stands steadfast in his heart, having no urgency, but has power over his own will, and has determined in his own heart to keep his own virgin, does well. ³⁸So then both he who gives his own virgin in marriage does well,

and he who doesn't give her in marriage does better. ³⁹A wife is bound by law for as long as her husband lives; but if the husband is dead, she is free to be married to whomever she desires, only in the Lord. ⁴⁰But she is happier if she stays as she is, in my judgment, and I think that I also have God's Spirit.

8Now concerning things sacrificed to idols: We know that we all have knowledge. Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up. ²But if anyone thinks that he knows anything, he doesn't yet know as he ought to know. ³But anyone who loves God is known by him. ⁴Therefore concerning the eating of things sacrificed to idols, we know that no idol is anything in the world, and that there is no other God but one. ⁵For though there are things that are called "gods", whether in the heavens or on earth—as there are many "gods" and many "lords"—⁶yet to us there is one God, the Father, of whom are all things, and we for him; and one Lord, Yeshua the Messiah, through whom are all things, and we live through him. ⁷However, that knowledge isn't in all men. But some, with consciousness of an idol until now, eat as of a thing sacrificed to an idol, and their conscience, being weak, is defiled. ⁸But food will not commend us to God. For neither, if we don't eat are we the worse, nor if we eat are we the better. ⁹But be careful that by no means does this liberty of yours become a stumbling block to the weak. ¹⁰For if a man sees you who have knowledge sitting in an idol's temple, won't his conscience, if he is weak, be emboldened to eat things sacrificed to idols? ¹¹And through your knowledge, he who is weak perishes, the brother for whose sake Messiah died. ¹²Thus, sinning against the brothers, and wounding their conscience when it is weak, you sin against Messiah. ¹³Therefore, if food causes my brother to stumble, I will eat no meat forever more, that I don't cause my brother to stumble.

9Am I not free? Am I not an emissary? Haven't I seen Yeshua the Messiah, our Lord? Aren't you my work in the Lord? ²If to others I am not an emissary, yet at least I am to you; for you are the seal of my office of emissary in the Lord. ³My defense to those who examine me is this: ⁴Have we no right to eat and to drink? ⁵Have we no right to take along a wife who is a believer, even as the rest of the emissaries, and the brothers of the Lord, and Kefa? ⁶Or have only Barnabas and I no right to not work? ⁷What soldier ever serves at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard, and doesn't eat of its fruit? Or who feeds a flock, and doesn't drink from the flock's milk? ⁸Do I speak these things according to the ways of men? Or doesn't the Torah also say the same thing? ⁹For it is written in the Torah of Moses, "You shall not muzzle an ox while it treads out the grain." Is it for the oxen that God cares, ¹⁰or does he say it assuredly for our sake? Yes, it was written for our sake, because he who plows ought to plow in hope,

and he who threshes in hope should partake of his hope. ¹¹If we sowed to you spiritual things, is it a great thing if we reap your fleshly things? ¹²If others partake of this right over you, don't we yet more? Nevertheless we didn't use this right, but we bear all things, that we may cause no hindrance to the Good News of Messiah. ¹³Don't you know that those who serve around sacred things eat from the things of the temple, and those who wait on the altar have their portion with the altar? ¹⁴Even so the Lord ordained that those who proclaim the Good News should live from the Good News. ¹⁵But I have used none of these things, and I don't write these things that it may be done so in my case; for I would rather die, than that anyone should make my boasting void. ¹⁶For if I proclaim the Good News, I have nothing to boast about, for necessity is laid on me; but woe is to me if I don't proclaim the Good News. ¹⁷For if I do this of my own will, I have a reward. But if not of my own will, I have a stewardship entrusted to me. ¹⁸What then is my reward? That when I proclaim the Good News, I may present the Good News of Messiah without charge, so as not to abuse my authority in the Good News. ¹⁹For though I was free from all, I brought myself under bondage to all, that I might gain the more. ²⁰To the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain Jews; to those who are under the law, as under the law, ^{iv} that I might gain those who are under the law; ²¹to those who are without law, as without law (not being without law toward God, but under law toward Messiah), that I might win those who are without law. ²²To the weak I became as weak, that I might gain the weak. I have become all things to all men, that I may by all means save some. ²³Now I do this for the sake of the Good News, that I may be a joint partaker of it. ²⁴Don't you know that those who run in a race all run, but one receives the prize? Run like that, so that you may win. ²⁵Every man who strives in the games exercises self-control in all things. Now they do it to receive a corruptible crown, but we an incorruptible. ²⁶I therefore run like that, not aimlessly. I fight like that, not beating the air, ²⁷but I beat my body and bring it into submission, lest by any means, after I have preached to others, I myself should be disqualified.

10 Now I would not have you ignorant, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the sea; ²and were all immersed into Moses in the cloud and in the sea; ³and all ate the same spiritual food; ⁴and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Messiah. ⁵However with most of them, God was not well pleased, for they were overthrown in the wilderness. ⁶Now these things were our examples, to the intent we should not lust after evil things as they also lusted. ⁷Don't be idolaters, as some of them were. As it is written, "The people sat

down to eat and drink, and rose up to play." ⁸Let's not commit sexual immorality, as some of them committed, and in one day twenty-three thousand fell. ⁹Let's not test Messiah, ^v as some of them tested, and perished by the serpents. ¹⁰Don't grumble, as some of them also grumbled, and perished by the destroyer. ¹¹Now all these things happened to them by way of example, and they were written for our admonition, on whom the ends of the ages have come. ¹²Therefore let him who thinks he stands be careful that he doesn't fall. ¹³No temptation has taken you except what is common to man. God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted above what you are able, but will with the temptation also make the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it. ¹⁴Therefore, my beloved, flee from idolatry. ¹⁵I speak as to wise men. Judge what I say. ¹⁶The cup of blessing which we bless, isn't it a sharing of the blood of Messiah? The bread which we break, isn't it a sharing of the body of Messiah? ¹⁷Because there is one loaf of bread, we, who are many, are one body; for we all partake of the one loaf of bread. ¹⁸Consider Israel according to the flesh. Don't those who eat the sacrifices participate in the altar? ¹⁹What am I saying then? That a thing sacrificed to idols is anything, or that an idol is anything? ²⁰But I say that the things which the Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to demons and not to God, and I don't desire that you would have fellowship with demons. ²¹You can't both drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons. You can't both partake of the table of the Lord and of the table of demons. ²²Or do we provoke the Lord to jealousy? Are we stronger than he? ²³"All things are lawful for me," but not all things are profitable. "All things are lawful for me," but not all things build up. ²⁴Let no one seek his own, but each one his neighbor's good. ²⁵Whatever is sold in the butcher shop, eat, asking no question for the sake of conscience, ²⁶for "the earth is the Lord's, and its fullness." ²⁷But if one of those who don't believe invites you to a meal, and you are inclined to go, eat whatever is set before you, asking no questions for the sake of conscience. ²⁸But if anyone says to you, "This was offered to idols," don't eat it for the sake of the one who told you, and for the sake of conscience. For "the earth is the Lord's, with all its fullness." ²⁹Conscience, I say, not your own, but the other's conscience. For why is my liberty judged by another conscience? ³⁰If I partake with thankfulness, why am I denounced for something I give thanks for? ³¹Whether therefore you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God. ³²Give no occasion for stumbling, whether to Jews, to Greeks, or to the assembly of God; ³³even as I also please all men in all things, not seeking my own profit, but the profit of the many, that they may be saved.

11 Be imitators of me, even as I also am of Messiah.

^{iv}NU adds: though I myself am not under the law

^vNU reads "the Lord" instead of "Messiah".

²Now I praise you, brothers, that you remember me in all things, and hold firm the traditions, even as I delivered them to you. ³But I would have you know that the head ^{vi} of every man is Messiah, and the head ^{vii} of the woman is man, and the head ^{viii} of Messiah is God. ⁴Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonors his head. ⁵But every woman praying or prophesying with her head uncovered dishonors her head. For it is one and the same thing as if she were shaved. ⁶For if a woman is not covered, let her hair also be cut off. But if it is shameful for a woman to have her hair cut off or be shaved, let her be covered. ⁷For a man indeed ought not to have his head covered, because he is the image and glory of God, but the woman is the glory of the man. ⁸For man is not from woman, but woman from man; ⁹for man wasn't created for the woman, but woman for the man. ¹⁰For this cause the woman ought to have authority over her own head, because of the angels. ¹¹Nevertheless, neither is the woman independent of the man, nor the man independent of the woman, in the Lord. ¹²For as woman came from man, so a man also comes through a woman; but all things are from God. ¹³Judge for yourselves. Is it appropriate that a woman pray to God unveiled? ¹⁴Doesn't even nature itself teach you that if a man has long hair, it is a dishonor to him? ¹⁵But if a woman has long hair, it is a glory to her, for her hair is given to her for a covering. ¹⁶But if any man seems to be contentious, we have no such custom, neither do God's assemblies. ¹⁷But in giving you this command I don't praise you, because you come together not for the better but for the worse. ¹⁸For first of all, when you come together in the assembly, I hear that divisions exist among you, and I partly believe it. ¹⁹For there also must be factions among you, that those who are approved may be revealed among you. ²⁰When therefore you assemble yourselves together, it is not the Lord's supper that you eat. ²¹For in your eating each one takes his own supper first. One is hungry, and another is drunken. ²²What, don't you have houses to eat and to drink in? Or do you despise God's assembly and put them to shame who don't have enough? What shall I tell you? Shall I praise you? In this I don't praise you. ²³For I received from the Lord that which also I delivered to you, that the Lord Yeshua on the night in which he was betrayed took bread. ²⁴When he had given thanks, he broke it and said, "Take, eat. This is my body, which is broken for you. Do this in memory of me." ²⁵In the same way he also took the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood. Do this, as often as you drink, in memory of me." ²⁶For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes. ²⁷Therefore whoever eats this bread or drinks the Lord's cup in a way unworthy of

the Lord will be guilty of the body and the blood of the Lord. ²⁸But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup. ²⁹For he who eats and drinks in an unworthy way eats and drinks judgment to himself if he doesn't discern the Lord's body. ³⁰For this cause many among you are weak and sickly, and not a few sleep. ³¹For if we discerned ourselves, we wouldn't be judged. ³²But when we are judged, we are disciplined by the Lord, that we may not be condemned with the world. ³³Therefore, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait for one another. ³⁴But if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home, lest your coming together be for judgment. The rest I will set in order whenever I come.

12Now concerning spiritual things, brothers, I don't want you to be ignorant. ²You know that when you were heathen, ^{ix} you were led away to those mute idols, however you might be led. ³Therefore I make known to you that no man speaking by God's Spirit says, "Yeshua is accursed." No one can say, "Yeshua is Lord," but by the Holy Spirit. ⁴Now there are various kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit. ⁵There are various kinds of service, and the same Lord. ⁶There are various kinds of workings, but the same God who works all things in all. ⁷But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the profit of all. ⁸For to one is given through the Spirit the word of wisdom, and to another the word of knowledge according to the same Spirit, ⁹to another faith by the same Spirit, and to another gifts of healings by the same Spirit, ¹⁰and to another workings of miracles, and to another prophecy, and to another discerning of spirits, to another different kinds of languages, and to another the interpretation of languages. ¹¹But the one and the same Spirit produces all of these, distributing to each one separately as he desires. ¹²For as the body is one and has many members, and all the members of the body, being many, are one body; so also is Messiah. ¹³For in one Spirit we were all immersed into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether bond or free; and were all given to drink into one Spirit. ¹⁴For the body is not one member, but many. ¹⁵If the foot would say, "Because I'm not the hand, I'm not part of the body," it is not therefore not part of the body. ¹⁶If the ear would say, "Because I'm not the eye, I'm not part of the body," it's not therefore not part of the body. ¹⁷If the whole body were an eye, where would the hearing be? If the whole were hearing, where would the smelling be? ¹⁸But now God has set the members, each one of them, in the body, just as he desired. ¹⁹If they were all one member, where would the body be? ²⁰But now they are many members, but one body. ²¹The eye can't tell the hand, "I have no need for you," or again the head to the feet, "I have no need for you." ²²No, much rather, those members of the body which seem to be weaker are necessary. ²³Those

^{vi}or, origin

^{vii}or, origin

^{viii}or, origin

^{ix}or Gentiles

parts of the body which we think to be less honorable, on those we bestow more abundant honor; and our unrepresentable parts have more abundant modesty, ²⁴while our representable parts have no such need. But God composed the body together, giving more abundant honor to the inferior part, ²⁵that there should be no division in the body, but that the members should have the same care for one another. ²⁶When one member suffers, all the members suffer with it. When one member is honored, all the members rejoice with it. ²⁷Now you are the body of Messiah, and members individually. ²⁸God has set some in the assembly: first emissaries, second prophets, third teachers, then miracle workers, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, and various kinds of languages. ²⁹Are all emissaries? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Are all miracle workers? ³⁰Do all have gifts of healings? Do all speak with various languages? Do all interpret? ³¹But earnestly desire the best gifts. Moreover, I show a most excellent way to you.

13If I speak with the languages of men and of angels, but don't have love, I have become sounding brass or a clanging cymbal. ²If I have the gift of prophecy, and know all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have all faith, so as to remove mountains, but don't have love, I am nothing. ³If I give away all my goods to feed the poor, and if I give my body to be burned, but don't have love, it profits me nothing. ⁴Love is patient and is kind. Love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud, ⁵doesn't behave itself inappropriately, doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil; ⁶doesn't rejoice in unrighteousness, but rejoices with the truth; ⁷bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, and endures all things. ⁸Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will be done away with. Where there are various languages, they will cease. Where there is knowledge, it will be done away with. ⁹For we know in part and we prophesy in part; ¹⁰but when that which is complete has come, then that which is partial will be done away with. ¹¹When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I felt as a child, I thought as a child. Now that I have become a man, I have put away childish things. ¹²For now we see in a mirror, dimly, but then face to face. Now I know in part, but then I will know fully, even as I was also fully known. ¹³But now faith, hope, and love remain—these three. The greatest of these is love.

14Follow after love and earnestly desire spiritual gifts, but especially that you may prophesy. ²For he who speaks in another language speaks not to men, but to God, for no one understands, but in the Spirit he speaks mysteries. ³But he who prophesies speaks to men for their edification, exhortation, and consolation. ⁴He who speaks in another language edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the assembly. ⁵Now I desire to have you all speak with other languages, but even more that you would prophesy. For he

is greater who prophesies than he who speaks with other languages, unless he interprets, that the assembly may be built up. ⁶But now, brothers, ^x if I come to you speaking with other languages, what would I profit you unless I speak to you either by way of revelation, or of knowledge, or of prophesying, or of teaching? ⁷Even lifeless things that make a sound, whether pipe or harp, if they didn't give a distinction in the sounds, how would it be known what is piped or harped? ⁸For if the shofar gave an uncertain sound, who would prepare himself for war? ⁹So also you, unless you uttered by the tongue words easy to understand, how would it be known what is spoken? For you would be speaking into the air. ¹⁰There are, it may be, so many kinds of languages in the world, and none of them is without meaning. ¹¹If then I don't know the meaning of the language, I would be to him who speaks a foreigner, and he who speaks would be a foreigner to me. ¹²So also you, since you are zealous for spiritual gifts, seek that you may abound to the building up of the assembly. ¹³Therefore let him who speaks in another language pray that he may interpret. ¹⁴For if I pray in another language, my spirit prays, but my understanding is unfruitful. ¹⁵What should I do? I will pray with the spirit, and I will pray with the understanding also. I will sing with the spirit, and I will sing with the understanding also. ¹⁶Otherwise, if you bless with the spirit, how will he who fills the place of the unlearned say the "Amen" at your giving of thanks, seeing he doesn't know what you say? ¹⁷For you most certainly give thanks well, but the other person is not built up. ¹⁸I thank my God, I speak with other languages more than you all. ¹⁹However, in the assembly I would rather speak five words with my understanding, that I might instruct others also, than ten thousand words in another language. ²⁰Brothers, don't be children in thoughts, yet in malice be babies, but in thoughts be mature. ²¹In the law it is written, "By men of strange languages and by the lips of strangers I will speak to this people. They won't even listen to me that way, says the Lord." ²²Therefore other languages are for a sign, not to those who believe, but to the unbelieving; but prophesying is for a sign, not to the unbelieving, but to those who believe. ²³If therefore the whole assembly is assembled together and all speak with other languages, and unlearned or unbelieving people come in, won't they say that you are crazy? ²⁴But if all prophesy, and someone unbelieving or unlearned comes in, he is reprov'd by all, and he is judged by all. ²⁵And thus the secrets of his heart are revealed. So he will fall down on his face and worship God, declaring that God is among you indeed. ²⁶What is it then, brothers? When you come together, each one of you has a psalm, has a teaching, has a revelation, has another language, or has an interpretation. Let all things be done to build each other up. ²⁷If any man speaks in another lan-

^xThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

guage, let there be two, or at the most three, and in turn; and let one interpret. ²⁸But if there is no interpreter, let him keep silent in the assembly, and let him speak to himself and to God. ²⁹Let two or three of the prophets speak, and let the others discern. ³⁰But if a revelation is made to another sitting by, let the first keep silent. ³¹For you all can prophesy one by one, that all may learn and all may be exhorted. ³²The spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets, ³³for God is not a God of confusion but of peace, as in all the assemblies of the holy ones. ³⁴Let the wives be quiet in the assemblies, for it has not been permitted for them to be talking except in submission, as the law also says, ³⁵if they desire to learn anything. "Let them ask their own husbands at home, for it is shameful for a wife to be talking in the assembly." ³⁶What!? Was it from you that the word of God went out? Or did it come to you alone? ³⁷If any man thinks himself to be a prophet or spiritual, let him recognize the things which I write to you, that they are the commandment of the Lord. ³⁸But if anyone is ignorant, let him be ignorant. ³⁹Therefore, brothers, desire earnestly to prophesy, and don't forbid speaking with other languages. ⁴⁰Let all things be done decently and in order.

15Now I declare to you, brothers, the Good News which I preached to you, which also you received, in which you also stand, ²by which also you are saved, if you hold firmly the word which I preached to you—unless you believed in vain. ³For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received: that Messiah died for our sins according to the Scriptures, ⁴that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures, ⁵and that he appeared to Kefa, then to the twelve. ⁶Then he appeared to over five hundred brothers at once, most of whom remain until now, but some have also fallen asleep. ⁷Then he appeared to Jacob, then to all the emissaries, ⁸and last of all, as to the child born at the wrong time, he appeared to me also. ⁹For I am the least of the emissaries, who is not worthy to be called an emissary, because I persecuted the assembly of God. ¹⁰But by the grace of God I am what I am. His grace which was given to me was not futile, but I worked more than all of them; yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me. ¹¹Whether then it is I or they, so we proclaim, and so you believed. ¹²Now if Messiah is preached, that he has been raised from the dead, how do some among you say that there is no resurrection of the dead? ¹³But if there is no resurrection of the dead, neither has Messiah been raised. ¹⁴If Messiah has not been raised, then our proclaiming is in vain and your faith also is in vain. ¹⁵Yes, we are also found false witnesses of God, because we testified about God that he raised up Messiah, whom he didn't raise up if it is true that the dead are not raised. ¹⁶For if the dead aren't raised, neither has Messiah been raised. ¹⁷If Messiah has not been raised, your faith

is vain; you are still in your sins. ¹⁸Then they also who are fallen asleep in Messiah have perished. ¹⁹If we have only hoped in Messiah in this life, we are of all men most pitiable. ²⁰But now Messiah has been raised from the dead. He became the first fruit of those who are asleep. ²¹For since death came by man, the resurrection of the dead also came by man. ²²For as in Adam all die, so also in Messiah all will be made alive. ²³But each in his own order: Messiah the first fruits, then those who are Messiah's at his coming. ²⁴Then the end comes, when he will deliver up the Kingdom to God the Father, when he will have abolished all rule and all authority and power. ²⁵For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. ²⁶The last enemy that will be abolished is death. ²⁷For, "He put all things in subjection under his feet." But when he says, "All things are put in subjection", it is evident that he is excepted who subjected all things to him. ²⁸When all things have been subjected to him, then the Son will also himself be subjected to him who subjected all things to him, that God may be all in all. ²⁹Or else what will they do who are immersed for the dead? If the dead aren't raised at all, why then are they immersed for the dead? ³⁰Why do we also stand in jeopardy every hour? ³¹I affirm, by the boasting in you which I have in Messiah Yeshua our Lord, I die daily. ³²If I fought with animals at Ephesus for human purposes, what does it profit me? If the dead are not raised, then "let's eat and drink, for tomorrow we die." ³³Don't be deceived! "Evil companionships corrupt good morals." ³⁴Wake up righteously and don't sin, for some have no knowledge of God. I say this to your shame. ³⁵But someone will say, "How are the dead raised?" and, "With what kind of body do they come?" ³⁶You foolish one, that which you yourself sow is not made alive unless it dies. ³⁷That which you sow, you don't sow the body that will be, but a bare grain, maybe of wheat, or of some other kind. ³⁸But God gives it a body even as it pleased him, and to each seed a body of its own. ³⁹All flesh is not the same flesh, but there is one flesh of men, another flesh of animals, another of fish, and another of birds. ⁴⁰There are also celestial bodies and terrestrial bodies; but the glory of the celestial differs from that of the terrestrial. ⁴¹There is one glory of the sun, another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars; for one star differs from another star in glory. ⁴²So also is the resurrection of the dead. The body is sown perishable; it is raised imperishable. ⁴³It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. ⁴⁴It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body and there is also a spiritual body. ⁴⁵So also it is written, "The first man Adam became a living soul." The last Adam became a life-giving spirit. ⁴⁶However, that which is spiritual isn't first, but that which is natural, then that which is spiritual. ⁴⁷The first man is of the earth, made of dust. The second man is the Lord from heaven. ⁴⁸As is the one made

of dust, such are those who are also made of dust; and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly. ⁴⁹As we have borne the image of those made of dust, let's ^{xi} also bear the image of the heavenly. ⁵⁰Now I say this, brothers, ^{xii} that flesh and blood can't inherit God's Kingdom; neither does the perishable inherit imperishable. ⁵¹Behold, ^{xiii} I tell you a mystery. We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed, ⁵²in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last shofar. For the shofar will sound and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed. ⁵³For this perishable body must become imperishable, and this mortal must put on immortality. ⁵⁴But when this perishable body will have become imperishable, and this mortal will have put on immortality, then what is written will happen: "Death is swallowed up in victory." ⁵⁵"Death, where is your sting? Sheol, ^{xiv} where is your victory?" ⁵⁶The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. ⁵⁷But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁵⁸Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the Lord's work, because you know that your labor is not in vain in the Lord.

16Now concerning the collection for the holy ones: as I commanded the assemblies of Galatia, you do likewise. ²On the first day of every week, let each one of you save as he may prosper, that no collections are made when I come. ³When I arrive, I will send whoever you approve with letters to carry your gracious gift to Jerusalem. ⁴If it is appropriate for me to go also, they will go with me. ⁵I will come to you when I have passed through Macedonia, for I am passing through Macedonia. ⁶But with you it may be that I will stay with you, or even winter with you, that you may send me on my journey wherever I go. ⁷For I do not wish to see you now in passing, but I hope to stay a while with you, if the Lord permits. ⁸But I will stay at Ephesus until Shavu'ot, ⁹for a great and effective door has opened to me, and there are many adversaries. ¹⁰Now if Timothy comes, see that he is with you without fear, for he does the work of the Lord, as I also do. ¹¹Therefore let no one despise him. But set him forward on his journey in peace, that he may come to me; for I expect him with the brothers. ¹²Now concerning Apollos the brother, I strongly urged him to come to you with the brothers, but it was not at all his desire to come now; but he will come when he has an opportunity. ¹³Watch! Stand firm in the faith! Be courageous! Be strong! ¹⁴Let all that you do be done in love. ¹⁵Now I beg you, brothers—you know the house of Stephanas, that it is the first fruits of Achaia, and that

they have set themselves to serve the holy ones— ¹⁶that you also be in subjection to such, and to everyone who helps in the work and labors. ¹⁷I rejoice at the coming of Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus; for that which was lacking on your part, they supplied. ¹⁸For they refreshed my spirit and yours. Therefore acknowledge those who are like that. ¹⁹The assemblies of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you warmly in the Lord, together with the assembly that is in their house. ²⁰All the brothers greet you. Greet one another with a holy kiss. ²¹This greeting is by me, Paul, with my own hand. ²²If any man doesn't love the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, let him be cursed. ^{xv} Come, Lord! ^{xvi} ²³The grace of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you. ²⁴My love to all of you in Messiah Yeshua. Amen.

^{xi}NU, TR read "we will" instead of "let's"

^{xii}The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{xiii}"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{xiv}or, Hell

^{xv}Greek: anathema.

^{xvi}Aramaic: Maranatha!

2 Corinthians

¹Paul, an emissary of Messiah ⁱ Yeshua through the will of God, and Timothy our brother, to the assembly of God which is at Corinth, with all the holy ones who are in the whole of Achaia: ²Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ³Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, the Father of mercies and God of all comfort, ⁴who comforts us in all our affliction, that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, through the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God. ⁵For as the sufferings of Messiah abound to us, even so our comfort also abounds through Messiah. ⁶But if we are afflicted, it is for your comfort and salvation. If we are comforted, it is for your comfort, which produces in you the patient enduring of the same sufferings which we also suffer. ⁷Our hope for you is steadfast, knowing that, since you are partakers of the sufferings, so you are also of the comfort. ⁸For we don't desire to have you uninformed, brothers, ⁱⁱ concerning our affliction which happened to us in Asia: that we were weighed down exceedingly, beyond our power, so much that we despaired even of life. ⁹Yes, we ourselves have had the sentence of death within ourselves, that we should not trust in ourselves, but in God who raises the dead, ¹⁰who delivered us out of so great a death, and does deliver, on whom we have set our hope that he will also still deliver us, ¹¹you also helping together on our behalf by your supplication; that, for the gift given to us by means of many, thanks may be given by many persons on your behalf. ¹²For our boasting is this: the testimony of our conscience that in holiness and sincerity of God, not in fleshly wisdom but in the grace of God, we behaved ourselves in the world, and more abundantly toward you. ¹³For we write no other things to you than what you read or even acknowledge, and I hope you will acknowledge to the end—¹⁴as also you acknowledged us in part—that we are your boasting, even as you also are ours, in the day of our Lord Yeshua. ¹⁵In this confidence, I was determined to come first to you, that you might have a second benefit, ¹⁶and by you to pass into Macedonia, and again from Macedonia

to come to you, and to be sent forward by you on my journey to Judea. ¹⁷When I therefore planned this, did I show fickleness? Or the things that I plan, do I plan according to the flesh, that with me there should be the “Yes, yes” and the “No, no?” ¹⁸But as God is faithful, our word toward you was not “Yes and no.” ¹⁹For the Son of God, Yeshua the Messiah, who was preached among you by us—by me, Silvanus, and Timothy—was not “Yes and no,” but in him is “Yes.” ²⁰For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us. ²¹Now he who establishes us with you in Messiah and anointed us is God, ²²who also sealed us and gave us the down payment of the Spirit in our hearts. ²³But I call God for a witness to my soul, that to spare you, I didn't come to Corinth. ²⁴We don't control your faith, but are fellow workers with you for your joy. For you stand firm in faith.

²But I determined this for myself, that I would not come to you again in sorrow. ²For if I make you grieve, then who will make me glad but he who is made to grieve by me? ³And I wrote this very thing to you, so that when I came, I wouldn't have sorrow from them of whom I ought to rejoice; having confidence in you all that my joy would be shared by all of you. ⁴For out of much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote to you with many tears, not that you should be made to grieve, but that you might know the love that I have so abundantly for you. ⁵But if any has caused sorrow, he has caused sorrow not to me, but in part (that I not press too heavily) to you all. ⁶This punishment which was inflicted by the many is sufficient for such a one; ⁷so that, on the contrary, you should rather forgive him and comfort him, lest by any means such a one should be swallowed up with his excessive sorrow. ⁸Therefore I beg you to confirm your love toward him. ⁹For to this end I also wrote, that I might know the proof of you, whether you are obedient in all things. ¹⁰Now I also forgive whomever you forgive anything. For if indeed I have forgiven anything, I have forgiven that one for your sakes in the presence of Messiah, ¹¹that no advantage may be gained over us by Satan, for we are not ignorant of his schemes. ¹²Now when I came to Troas for the Good News of Messiah, and when a door was opened to me in the Lord, ¹³I had no relief for my spirit,

ⁱ“Messiah” means “Anointed One”.

ⁱⁱThe word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

because I didn't find Titus my brother, but taking my leave of them, I went out into Macedonia. ¹⁴Now thanks be to God who always leads us in triumph in Messiah, and reveals through us the sweet aroma of his knowledge in every place. ¹⁵For we are a sweet aroma of Messiah to God in those who are saved and in those who perish: ¹⁶to the one a stench from death to death, to the other a sweet aroma from life to life. Who is sufficient for these things? ¹⁷For we are not as so many, peddling the word of God. But as of sincerity, but as of God, in the sight of God, we speak in Messiah.

³Are we beginning again to commend ourselves? Or do we need, as do some, letters of commendation to you or from you? ²You are our letter, written in our hearts, known and read by all men, ³being revealed that you are a letter of Messiah, served by us, written not with ink, but with the Spirit of the living God; not in tablets of stone, but in tablets that are hearts of flesh. ⁴Such confidence we have through Messiah toward God, ⁵not that we are sufficient of ourselves to account anything as from ourselves; but our sufficiency is from God, ⁶who also made us sufficient as servants of a new covenant, not of the letter but of the Spirit. For the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life. ⁷But if the service of death, written engraved on stones, came with glory, so that the children of Israel could not look steadfastly on the face of Moses for the glory of his face, which was passing away, ⁸won't service of the Spirit be with much more glory? ⁹For if the service of condemnation has glory, the service of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. ¹⁰For most certainly that which has been made glorious has not been made glorious in this respect, by reason of the glory that surpasses. ¹¹For if that which passes away was with glory, much more that which remains is in glory. ¹²Having therefore such a hope, we use great boldness of speech, ¹³and not as Moses, who put a veil on his face so that the children of Israel wouldn't look steadfastly on the end of that which was passing away. ¹⁴But their minds were hardened, for until this very day at the reading of the old covenant the same veil remains, because in Messiah it passes away. ¹⁵But to this day, when Moses is read, a veil lies on their heart. ¹⁶But whenever someone turns to the Lord, the veil is taken away. ¹⁷Now the Lord is the Spirit; and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty. ¹⁸But we all, with unveiled face seeing the glory of the Lord as in a mirror, are transformed into the same image from glory to glory, even as from the Lord, the Spirit.

⁴Therefore, seeing we have this ministry, even as we obtained mercy, we don't faint. ²But we have renounced the hidden things of shame, not walking in craftiness nor handling the word of God deceitfully, but by the manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God. ³Even if our Good News

is veiled, it is veiled in those who are dying, ⁴in whom the god of this world has blinded the minds of the unbelieving, that the light of the Good News of the glory of Messiah, who is the image of God, should not dawn on them. ⁵For we don't proclaim ourselves, but Messiah Yeshua as Lord, and ourselves as your servants for Yeshua's sake, ⁶seeing it is God who said, "Light will shine out of darkness," who has shone in our hearts to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Yeshua the Messiah. ⁷But we have this treasure in clay vessels, that the exceeding greatness of the power may be of God and not from ourselves. ⁸We are pressed on every side, yet not crushed; perplexed, yet not to despair; ⁹pursued, yet not forsaken; struck down, yet not destroyed; ¹⁰always carrying in the body the putting to death of the Lord Yeshua, that the life of Yeshua may also be revealed in our body. ¹¹For we who live are always delivered to death for Yeshua's sake, that the life also of Yeshua may be revealed in our mortal flesh. ¹²So then death works in us, but life in you. ¹³But having the same spirit of faith, according to that which is written, "I believed, and therefore I spoke." We also believe, and therefore we also speak, ¹⁴knowing that he who raised the Lord Yeshua will raise us also with Yeshua, and will present us with you. ¹⁵For all things are for your sakes, that the grace, being multiplied through the many, may cause the thanksgiving to abound to the glory of God. ¹⁶Therefore we don't faint, but though our outward person is decaying, yet our inward person is renewed day by day. ¹⁷For our light affliction, which is for the moment, works for us more and more exceedingly an eternal weight of glory, ¹⁸while we don't look at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen. For the things which are seen are temporal, but the things which are not seen are eternal.

⁵For we know that if the earthly house of our tent is dissolved, we have a building from God, a house not made with hands, eternal, in the heavens. ²For most certainly in this we groan, longing to be clothed with our habitation which is from heaven, ³if indeed being clothed, we will not be found naked. ⁴For indeed we who are in this tent do groan, being burdened, not that we desire to be unclothed, but that we desire to be clothed, that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life. ⁵Now he who made us for this very thing is God, who also gave to us the down payment of the Spirit. ⁶Therefore we are always confident and know that while we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord; ⁷for we walk by faith, not by sight. ⁸We are courageous, I say, and are willing rather to be absent from the body and to be at home with the Lord. ⁹Therefore also we make it our aim, whether at home or absent, to be well pleasing to him. ¹⁰For we must all be revealed before the judgment seat of Messiah that each one may receive the things in the body according to what he has

done, whether good or bad. ¹¹Knowing therefore the fear of the Lord, we persuade men, but we are revealed to God, and I hope that we are revealed also in your consciences. ¹²For we are not commending ourselves to you again, but speak as giving you occasion of boasting on our behalf, that you may have something to answer those who boast in appearance and not in heart. ¹³For if we are beside ourselves, it is for God. Or if we are of sober mind, it is for you. ¹⁴For the love of Messiah compels us; because we judge thus: that one died for all, therefore all died. ¹⁵He died for all, that those who live should no longer live to themselves, but to him who for their sakes died and rose again. ¹⁶Therefore we know no one according to the flesh from now on. Even though we have known Messiah according to the flesh, yet now we know him so no more. ¹⁷Therefore if anyone is in Messiah, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ all things have become new. ¹⁸But all things are of God, who reconciled us to himself through Yeshua the Messiah, and gave to us the ministry of reconciliation; ¹⁹namely, that God was in Messiah reconciling the world to himself, not reckoning to them their trespasses, and having committed to us the word of reconciliation. ²⁰We are therefore ambassadors on behalf of Messiah, as though God were entreating by us: we beg you on behalf of Messiah, be reconciled to God. ²¹For him who knew no sin he made to be sin on our behalf, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

⁶Working together, we entreat also that you do not receive the grace of God in vain. ²For he says, “At an acceptable time I listened to you. In a day of salvation I helped you.” Behold, now is the acceptable time. Behold, now is the day of salvation. ³We give no occasion of stumbling in anything, that our service may not be blamed, ⁴but in everything commending ourselves as servants of God: in great endurance, in afflictions, in hardships, in distresses, ⁵in beatings, in imprisonments, in riots, in labors, in watchings, in fastings, ⁶in pureness, in knowledge, in perseverance, in kindness, in the Holy Spirit, in sincere love, ⁷in the word of truth, in the power of God, by the armor of righteousness on the right hand and on the left, ⁸by glory and dishonor, by evil report and good report, as deceivers and yet true, ⁹as unknown and yet well known, as dying and behold—we live, as punished and not killed, ¹⁰as sorrowful yet always rejoicing, as poor yet making many rich, as having nothing and yet possessing all things. ¹¹Our mouth is open to you, Corinthians. Our heart is enlarged. ¹²You are not restricted by us, but you are restricted by your own affections. ¹³Now in return—I speak as to my children—you also open your hearts. ¹⁴Don’t be unequally yoked with unbelievers, for what fellowship do righteousness and iniquity have? Or what fellowship does light have

with darkness? ¹⁵What agreement does Messiah have with Belial? Or what portion does a believer have with an unbeliever? ¹⁶What agreement does a temple of God have with idols? For you are a temple of the living God. Even as God said, “I will dwell in them and walk in them. I will be their God and they will be my people.” ¹⁷Therefore “‘Come out from among them, and be separate,’ says the Lord. ‘Touch no unclean thing. I will receive you. ¹⁸I will be to you a Father. You will be to me sons and daughters,’ says the Lord Almighty.”

⁷Having therefore these promises, beloved, let’s cleanse ourselves from all defilement of flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God. ²Open your hearts to us. We wronged no one. We corrupted no one. We took advantage of no one. ³I say this not to condemn you, for I have said before that you are in our hearts to die together and live together. ⁴Great is my boldness of speech toward you. Great is my boasting on your behalf. I am filled with comfort. I overflow with joy in all our affliction. ⁵For even when we had come into Macedonia, our flesh had no relief, but we were afflicted on every side. Fightings were outside. Fear was inside. ⁶Nevertheless, he who comforts the lowly, God, comforted us by the coming of Titus, ⁷and not by his coming only, but also by the comfort with which he was comforted in you while he told us of your longing, your mourning, and your zeal for me, so that I rejoiced still more. ⁸For though I grieved you with my letter, I do not regret it, though I did regret it. For I see that my letter made you grieve, though just for a while. ⁹I now rejoice, not that you were grieved, but that you were grieved to repentance. For you were grieved in a godly way, that you might suffer loss by us in nothing. ¹⁰For godly sorrow produces repentance leading to salvation, which brings no regret. But the sorrow of the world produces death. ¹¹For behold, this same thing, that you were grieved in a godly way, what earnest care it worked in you. Yes, what defense, indignation, fear, longing, zeal, and vindication! In everything you demonstrated yourselves to be pure in the matter. ¹²So although I wrote to you, I wrote not for his cause that did the wrong, nor for his cause that suffered the wrong, but that your earnest care for us might be revealed in you in the sight of God. ¹³Therefore we have been comforted. In our comfort we rejoiced the more exceedingly for the joy of Titus, because his spirit has been refreshed by you all. ¹⁴For if in anything I have boasted to him on your behalf, I was not disappointed. But as we spoke all things to you in truth, so our glorying also which I made before Titus was found to be truth. ¹⁵His affection is more abundantly toward you, while he remembers all of your obedience, how with fear and trembling you received him. ¹⁶I rejoice that in everything I am confident concerning you.

ⁱⁱⁱ“Behold”, from “ ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

8Moreover, brothers, we make known to you the grace of God which has been given in the assemblies of Macedonia, ²how in a severe ordeal of affliction, the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded to the riches of their generosity. ³For according to their power, I testify, yes and beyond their power, they gave of their own accord, ⁴begging us with much entreaty to receive this grace and the fellowship in the service to the holy ones. ⁵This was not as we had expected, but first they gave their own selves to the Lord, and to us through the will of God. ⁶So we urged Titus, that as he had made a beginning before, so he would also complete in you this grace. ⁷But as you abound in everything—in faith, utterance, knowledge, all earnestness, and in your love to us—see that you also abound in this grace. ⁸I speak not by way of commandment, but as proving through the earnestness of others the sincerity also of your love. ⁹For you know the grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, that though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that you through his poverty might become rich. ¹⁰I give advice in this: it is expedient for you who were the first to start a year ago, not only to do, but also to be willing. ¹¹But now complete the doing also, that as there was the readiness to be willing, so there may be the completion also out of your ability. ¹²For if the readiness is there, it is acceptable according to what you have, not according to what you don't have. ¹³For this is not that others may be eased and you distressed, ¹⁴but for equality. Your abundance at this present time supplies their lack, that their abundance also may become a supply for your lack, that there may be equality. ¹⁵As it is written, "He who gathered much had nothing left over, and he who gathered little had no lack." ¹⁶But thanks be to God, who puts the same earnest care for you into the heart of Titus. ¹⁷For he indeed accepted our exhortation, but being himself very earnest, he went out to you of his own accord. ¹⁸We have sent together with him the brother whose praise in the Good News is known throughout all the assemblies. ¹⁹Not only so, but he was also appointed by the assemblies to travel with us in this grace, which is served by us to the glory of the Lord himself, and to show our readiness. ²⁰We are avoiding this, that any man should blame us concerning this abundance which is administered by us. ²¹Having regard for honorable things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men. ²²We have sent with them our brother whom we have many times proved earnest in many things, but now much more earnest, by reason of the great confidence which he has in you. ²³As for Titus, he is my partner and fellow worker for you. As for our brothers, they are the emissaries of the assemblies, the glory of Messiah. ²⁴Therefore show the proof of your love to them before the assemblies, and of our boasting on your behalf.

9It is indeed unnecessary for me to write to you concern-

ing the service to the holy ones, ²for I know your readiness, of which I boast on your behalf to those of Macedonia, that Achaia has been prepared for the past year. Your zeal has stirred up very many of them. ³But I have sent the brothers so that our boasting on your behalf may not be in vain in this respect, that, just as I said, you may be prepared, ⁴lest by any means, if anyone from Macedonia comes there with me and finds you unprepared, we (to say nothing of you) would be disappointed in this confident boasting. ⁵I thought it necessary therefore to entreat the brothers that they would go before to you and arrange ahead of time the generous gift that you promised before, that the same might be ready as a matter of generosity, and not of greediness. ⁶Remember this: he who sows sparingly will also reap sparingly. He who sows bountifully will also reap bountifully. ⁷Let each man give according as he has determined in his heart, not grudgingly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver. ⁸And God is able to make all grace abound to you, that you, always having all sufficiency in everything, may abound to every good work. ⁹As it is written, "He has scattered abroad. He has given to the poor. His righteousness remains forever." ¹⁰Now may he who supplies seed to the sower and bread for food, supply and multiply your seed for sowing, and increase the fruits of your righteousness, ¹¹you being enriched in everything for all generosity, which produces thanksgiving to God through us. ¹²For this service of giving that you perform not only makes up for lack among the holy ones, but abounds also through much giving of thanks to God, ¹³seeing that through the proof given by this service, they glorify God for the obedience of your confession to the Good News of Messiah and for the generosity of your contribution to them and to all, ¹⁴while they themselves also, with supplication on your behalf, yearn for you by reason of the exceeding grace of God in you. ¹⁵Now thanks be to God for his unspeakable gift!

10Now I Paul, myself, entreat you by the humility and gentleness of Messiah, I who in your presence am lowly among you, but being absent am bold toward you. ²Yes, I beg you that I may not, when present, show courage with the confidence with which I intend to be bold against some, who consider us to be walking according to the flesh. ³For though we walk in the flesh, we don't wage war according to the flesh; ⁴for the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh, but mighty before God to the throwing down of strongholds, ⁵throwing down imaginations and every high thing that is exalted against the knowledge of God and bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Messiah, ⁶and being in readiness to avenge all disobedience when your obedience is made full. ⁷Do you look at things only as they appear in front of your face? If anyone trusts in himself that he is Messiah's, let him consider this again with himself, that even as he is Messiah's, so we also

are Messiah's. ⁸For even if I boast somewhat abundantly concerning our authority, which the Lord gave for building you up and not for casting you down, I will not be ashamed, ⁹that I may not seem as if I desire to terrify you by my letters. ¹⁰For, "His letters", they say, "are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech is despised." ¹¹Let such a person consider this, that what we are in word by letters when we are absent, such are we also in deed when we are present. ¹²For we are not bold to number or compare ourselves with some of those who commend themselves. But they themselves, measuring themselves by themselves, and comparing themselves with themselves, are without understanding. ¹³But we will not boast beyond proper limits, but within the boundaries with which God appointed to us, which reach even to you. ¹⁴For we don't stretch ourselves too much, as though we didn't reach to you. For we came even as far as to you with the Good News of Messiah, ¹⁵not boasting beyond proper limits in other men's labors, but having hope that as your faith grows, we will be abundantly enlarged by you in our sphere of influence, ¹⁶so as to proclaim the Good News even to the parts beyond you, not to boast in what someone else has already done. ¹⁷But "he who boasts, let him boast in the Lord." ¹⁸For it isn't he who commends himself who is approved, but whom the Lord commends.

11I wish that you would bear with me in a little foolishness, but indeed you do bear with me. ²For I am jealous over you with a godly jealousy. For I promised you in marriage to one husband, that I might present you as a pure virgin to Messiah. ³But I am afraid that somehow, as the serpent deceived Havah in his craftiness, so your minds might be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Messiah. ⁴For if he who comes preaches another Yeshua whom we didn't proclaim, or if you receive a different spirit which you didn't receive, or a different "good news" which you didn't accept, you put up with that well enough. ⁵For I reckon that I am not at all behind the very best emissaries. ⁶But though I am unskilled in speech, yet I am not unskilled in knowledge. No, in every way we have been revealed to you in all things. ⁷Or did I commit a sin in humbling myself that you might be exalted, because I preached to you God's Good News free of charge? ⁸I robbed other assemblies, taking wages from them that I might serve you. ⁹When I was present with you and was in need, I wasn't a burden on anyone, for the brothers, when they came from Macedonia, supplied the measure of my need. In everything I kept myself from being burdensome to you, and I will continue to do so. ¹⁰As the truth of Messiah is in me, no one will stop me from this boasting in the regions of Achaia. ¹¹Why? Because I don't love you? God knows. ¹²But what I do, that I will continue to do, that I may cut off opportunity from those who desire an opportunity, that in which they boast, they may be recognized just like

us. ¹³For such men are false emissaries, deceitful workers, masquerading as Messiah's emissaries. ¹⁴And no wonder, for even Satan masquerades as an angel of light. ¹⁵It is no great thing therefore if his servants also masquerade as servants of righteousness, whose end will be according to their works. ¹⁶I say again, let no one think me foolish. But if so, yet receive me as foolish, that I also may boast a little. ¹⁷That which I speak, I don't speak according to the Lord, but as in foolishness, in this confidence of boasting. ¹⁸Seeing that many boast after the flesh, I will also boast. ¹⁹For you bear with the foolish gladly, being wise. ²⁰For you bear with a man if he brings you into bondage, if he devours you, if he takes you captive, if he exalts himself, or if he strikes you on the face. ²¹To my shame, I speak as though we had been weak. Yet in whatever way anyone is bold (I speak in foolishness), I am bold also. ²²Are they Hebrews? So am I. Are they Israelites? So am I. Are they the offspring ^{iv} of Abraham? So am I. ²³Are they servants of Messiah? (I speak as one beside himself.) I am more so: in labors more abundantly, in prisons more abundantly, in stripes above measure, and in deaths often. ²⁴Five times I received forty stripes minus one from the Jews. ²⁵Three times I was beaten with rods. Once I was stoned. Three times I suffered shipwreck. I have been a night and a day in the deep. ²⁶I have been in travels often, perils of rivers, perils of robbers, perils from my countrymen, perils from the Gentiles, perils in the city, perils in the wilderness, perils in the sea, perils among false brothers; ²⁷in labor and travail, in watchings often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings often, and in cold and nakedness. ²⁸Besides those things that are outside, there is that which presses on me daily: anxiety for all the assemblies. ²⁹Who is weak, and I am not weak? Who is caused to stumble, and I don't burn with indignation? ³⁰If I must boast, I will boast of the things that concern my weakness. ³¹The God and Father of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, he who is blessed forever more, knows that I don't lie. ³²In Damascus the governor under King Aretas guarded the Damascenes' city, desiring to arrest me. ³³I was let down in a basket through a window by the wall, and escaped his hands.

12It is doubtless not profitable for me to boast, but I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord. ²I know a man in Messiah who was caught up into the third heaven fourteen years ago—whether in the body, I don't know, or whether out of the body, I don't know; God knows. ³I know such a man (whether in the body, or outside of the body, I don't know; God knows), ⁴how he was caught up into Paradise and heard unspeakable words, which it is not lawful for a man to utter. ⁵On behalf of such a one I will boast, but on my own behalf I will not boast, except in my weaknesses. ⁶For if I would desire to boast, I will not be foolish; for I will speak the truth. But I

^{iv}or, seed

refrain, so that no man may think more of me than that which he sees in me or hears from me. ⁷By reason of the exceeding greatness of the revelations, that I should not be exalted excessively, a thorn in the flesh was given to me: a messenger of Satan to torment me, that I should not be exalted excessively. ⁸Concerning this thing, I begged the Lord three times that it might depart from me. ⁹He has said to me, “My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness.” Most gladly therefore I will rather glory in my weaknesses, that the power of Messiah may rest on me. ¹⁰Therefore I take pleasure in weaknesses, in injuries, in necessities, in persecutions, and in distresses, for Messiah’s sake. For when I am weak, then am I strong. ¹¹I have become foolish in boasting. You compelled me, for I ought to have been commended by you, for I am in no way inferior to the very best emissaries, though I am nothing. ¹²Truly the signs of an emissary were worked among you in all perseverance, in signs and wonders and mighty works. ¹³For what is there in which you were made inferior to the rest of the assemblies, unless it is that I myself was not a burden to you? Forgive me this wrong! ¹⁴Behold, this is the third time I am ready to come to you, and I will not be a burden to you; for I seek not your possessions, but you. For the children ought not to save up for the parents, but the parents for the children. ¹⁵I will most gladly spend and be spent for your souls. If I love you more abundantly, am I loved the less? ¹⁶Even so, I myself didn’t burden you. But you might say that being crafty, I caught you with deception. ¹⁷Did I take advantage of you by anyone of those whom I have sent to you? ¹⁸I exhorted Titus, and I sent the brother with him. Did Titus take any advantage of you? Didn’t we walk in the same spirit? Didn’t we walk in the same steps? ¹⁹Again, do you think that we are excusing ourselves to you? In the sight of God we speak in Messiah. But all things, beloved, are for your edifying. ²⁰For I am afraid that perhaps when I come, I might find you not the way I want to, and that I might be found by you as you don’t desire, that perhaps there would be strife, jealousy, outbursts of anger, factions, slander, whisperings, proud thoughts, or riots, ²¹that again when I come my God would humble me before you, and I would mourn for many of those who have sinned before now, and not repented of the uncleanness, sexual immorality, and lustfulness which they committed.

13This is the third time I am coming to you. “At the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word be established.” ²I have warned previously, and I warn again, as when I was present the second time, so now, being absent, I write to those who have sinned before now and to all the rest that if I come again, I will not spare, ³seeing that you seek a proof of Messiah who speaks in me who is not weak, but is powerful in you. ⁴For he was crucified through weakness, yet he lives through the power of God. For we also are

weak in him, but we will live with him through the power of God toward you. ⁵Examine your own selves, whether you are in the faith. Test your own selves. Or don’t you know about your own selves, that Yeshua the Messiah is in you?—unless indeed you are disqualified. ⁶But I hope that you will know that we aren’t disqualified. ⁷Now I pray to God that you do no evil; not that we may appear approved, but that you may do that which is honorable, though we may seem to have failed. ⁸For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth. ⁹For we rejoice when we are weak and you are strong. We also pray for this: your becoming perfect. ¹⁰For this cause I write these things while absent, that I may not deal sharply when present, according to the authority which the Lord gave me for building up and not for tearing down. ¹¹Finally, brothers, rejoice! Be perfected. Be comforted. Be of the same mind. Live in peace, and the God of love and peace will be with you. ¹²Greet one another with a holy kiss. ¹³All the holy ones greet you. ¹⁴The grace of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, God’s love, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all. Amen.

Galatians

¹Paul, an emissary—not from men, nor through man, but through Yeshua the Messiah,ⁱ and God the Father, who raised him from the dead—²and all the brothersⁱⁱ who are with me, to the assemblies of Galatia: ³Grace to you and peace from God the Father and our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ⁴who gave himself for our sins, that he might deliver us out of this present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father—⁵to whom be the glory forever and ever. Amen. ⁶I marvel that you are so quickly deserting him who called you in the grace of Messiah to a different “good news”, ⁷but there isn’t another “good news.” Only there are some who trouble you and want to pervert the Good News of Messiah. ⁸But even though we, or an angel from heaven, should proclaim to you any “good news” other than that which we preached to you, let him be cursed. ⁹As we have said before, so I now say again: if any man preaches to you any “good news” other than that which you received, let him be cursed. ¹⁰For am I now seeking the favor of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? For if I were still pleasing men, I wouldn’t be a servant of Messiah. ¹¹But I make known to you, brothers, concerning the Good News which was preached by me, that it is not according to man. ¹²For I didn’t receive it from man, nor was I taught it, but it came to me through revelation of Yeshua the Messiah. ¹³For you have heard of my way of living in time past in Judaismⁱⁱⁱ, or, traditional Judaism how that beyond measure I persecuted the assembly of God and ravaged it. ¹⁴I advanced in Judaism^{iv} or, traditional Judaism beyond many of my own age among my countrymen, being more exceedingly zealous for the traditions of my fathers. ¹⁵But when it was the good pleasure of God, who separated me from my mother’s womb and called me through his grace, ¹⁶to reveal his Son in me, that I might proclaim him among the Gentiles, I didn’t immediately confer with flesh and blood, ¹⁷nor did I go up to Jerusalem to those who were emissaries before me, but I went away into Arabia. Then I returned to Damascus. ¹⁸Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to visit

Peter, and stayed with him fifteen days. ¹⁹But of the other emissaries I saw no one except Jacob, the Lord’s brother. ²⁰Now about the things which I write to you, behold,^v before God, I’m not lying. ²¹Then I came to the regions of Syria and Cilicia. ²²I was still unknown by face to the assemblies of Judea which were in Messiah, ²³but they only heard, “He who once persecuted us now preaches the faith that he once tried to destroy.” ²⁴So they glorified God in me.

²Then after a period of fourteen years I went up again to Jerusalem with Barnabas, taking Titus also with me. ²I went up by revelation, and I laid before them the Good News which I proclaim among the Gentiles, but privately before those who were respected, for fear that I might be running, or had run, in vain. ³But not even Titus, who was with me, being a Greek, was compelled to be circumcised. ⁴This was because of the false brothers secretly brought in, who stole in to spy out our liberty which we have in Messiah Yeshua, that they might bring us into bondage, ⁵to whom we gave no place in the way of subjection, not for an hour, that the truth of the Good News might continue with you. ⁶But from those who were reputed to be important—whatever they were, it makes no difference to me; God doesn’t show partiality to man—they, I say, who were respected imparted nothing to me, ⁷but to the contrary, when they saw that I had been entrusted with the Good News for the uncircumcised, even as Peter with the Good News for the circumcised—⁸for he who worked through Peter in the apostleship with the circumcised also worked through me with the Gentiles—⁹and when they perceived the grace that was given to me, Jacob and Kefa and Yochanan, those who were reputed to be pillars, gave to Barnabas and me the right hand of fellowship, that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcision. ¹⁰They only asked us to remember the poor—which very thing I was also zealous to do. ¹¹But when Peter came to Antioch, I resisted him to his face, because he stood condemned. ¹²For before some people came from Jacob, he ate with the Gentiles. But when they came, he drew back and separated himself, fearing those who were of the

ⁱ“Messiah” means “Anointed One”.

ⁱⁱThe word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

ⁱⁱⁱor, traditional Judaism,

^{iv}or, traditional Judaism

^v“Behold”, from “ ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

circumcision. ¹³And the rest of the Jewish believers joined him in his hypocrisy, so that even Barnabas was carried away with their hypocrisy. ¹⁴But when I saw that they didn't walk uprightly according to the truth of the Good News, I said to Peter before them all, "If you, being a Jew, live as the Gentiles do, and not as the Jews do, why do you compel the Gentiles to live as the Jews do?" ¹⁵"We, being Jews by birth and not Gentile sinners, ¹⁶yet knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law but through faith in Yeshua the Messiah, even we believed in Messiah Yeshua, that we might be justified by faith in Messiah and not by the works of the law, because no flesh will be justified by the works of the law. ¹⁷But if while we sought to be justified in Messiah, we ourselves also were found sinners, is Messiah a servant of sin? Certainly not! ¹⁸For if I build up again those things which I destroyed, I prove myself a law-breaker. ¹⁹For I through the law died to the law, that I might live to God. ²⁰I have been crucified with Messiah, and it is no longer I who live, but Messiah lives in me. That life which I now live in the flesh, I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself up for me. ²¹I don't reject the grace of God. For if righteousness is through the law, then Messiah died for nothing!"

3Foolish Galatians, who has bewitched you not to obey the truth, before whose eyes Yeshua the Messiah was openly portrayed among you as crucified? ²I just want to learn this from you: Did you receive the Spirit by the works of the law, or by hearing of faith? ³Are you so foolish? Having begun in the Spirit, are you now completed in the flesh? ⁴Did you suffer so many things in vain, if it is indeed in vain? ⁵He therefore who supplies the Spirit to you and does miracles among you, does he do it by the works of the law, or by hearing of faith? ⁶Even so, Abraham "believed God, and it was counted to him for righteousness." ⁷Know therefore that those who are of faith are children of Abraham. ⁸The Scripture, foreseeing that God would justify the Gentiles by faith, preached the Good News beforehand to Abraham, saying, "In you all the nations will be blessed." ⁹So then, those who are of faith are blessed with the faithful Abraham. ¹⁰For as many as are of the works of the law are under a curse. For it is written, "Cursed is everyone who doesn't continue in all things that are written in the scroll of the Torah, to do them." ¹¹Now that no man is justified by the law before God is evident, for, "The righteous will live by faith." ¹²The law is not of faith, but, "The man who does them will live by them." ¹³Messiah redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us. For it is written, "Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree," ¹⁴that the blessing of Abraham might come on the Gentiles through Messiah Yeshua, that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith. ¹⁵Brothers, speaking of human terms, though it is only a man's covenant, yet when it has been confirmed, no one

makes it void or adds to it. ¹⁶Now the promises were spoken to Abraham and to his offspring. ^{vi} He doesn't say, "To descendants ^{vii} ", as of many, but as of one, "To your offspring", which is Messiah. ¹⁷Now I say this: A covenant confirmed beforehand by God in Messiah, the law, which came four hundred thirty years after, does not annul, so as to make the promise of no effect. ¹⁸For if the inheritance is of the law, it is no more of promise; but God has granted it to Abraham by promise. ¹⁹Then why is there the law? It was added because of transgressions, until the offspring should come to whom the promise has been made. It was ordained through angels by the hand of a mediator. ²⁰Now a mediator is not between one, but God is one. ²¹Is the law then against the promises of God? Certainly not! For if there had been a law given which could make alive, most certainly righteousness would have been of the law. ²²But the Scripture imprisoned all things under sin, that the promise by faith in Yeshua the Messiah might be given to those who believe. ²³But before faith came, we were kept in custody under the law, confined for the faith which should afterwards be revealed. ²⁴So that the law has become our tutor to bring us to Messiah, that we might be justified by faith. ²⁵But now that faith has come, we are no longer under a tutor. ²⁶For you are all children of God, through faith in Messiah Yeshua. ²⁷For as many of you as were immersed into Messiah have put on Messiah. ²⁸There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free man, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Messiah Yeshua. ²⁹If you are Messiah's, then you are Abraham's offspring and heirs according to promise.

4But I say that so long as the heir is a child, he is no different from a bondservant, though he is lord of all, ²but is under guardians and stewards until the day appointed by the father. ³So we also, when we were children, were held in bondage under the elemental principles of the world. ⁴But when the fullness of the time came, God sent out his Son, born to a woman, born under the law, ⁵that he might redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as children. ⁶And because you are children, God sent out the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, "Abba, ^{viii} Father!" ⁷So you are no longer a bondservant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Messiah. ⁸However at that time, not knowing God, you were in bondage to those who by nature are not gods. ⁹But now that you have come to know God, or rather to be known by God, why do you turn back again to the weak and miserable elemental principles, to which you desire to be in bondage all over again? ¹⁰You observe days, months, seasons, and years. ¹¹I am afraid for you,

^{vi}or, seed

^{vii}or, seeds

^{viii}Abba is a Greek spelling for the Aramaic word for "Father" or "Daddy" used in a familiar, respectful, and loving way.

that I might have wasted my labor for you. ¹²I beg you, brothers, become as I am, for I also have become as you are. You did me no wrong, ¹³but you know that because of weakness in the flesh I preached the Good News to you the first time. ¹⁴That which was a temptation to you in my flesh, you didn't despise nor reject; but you received me as an angel of God, even as Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁵What was the blessing you enjoyed? For I testify to you that, if possible, you would have plucked out your eyes and given them to me. ¹⁶So then, have I become your enemy by telling you the truth? ¹⁷They zealously seek you in no good way. No, they desire to alienate you, that you may seek them. ¹⁸But it is always good to be zealous in a good cause, and not only when I am present with you. ¹⁹My little children, of whom I am again in travail until Messiah is formed in you—²⁰but I could wish to be present with you now, and to change my tone, for I am perplexed about you. ²¹Tell me, you that desire to be under the law, don't you listen to the law? ²²For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by the servant, and one by the free woman. ²³However, the son by the servant was born according to the flesh, but the son by the free woman was born through promise. ²⁴These things contain an allegory, for these are two covenants. One is from Mount Sinai, bearing children to bondage, which is Hagar. ²⁵For this Hagar is Mount Sinai in Arabia, and answers to the Jerusalem that exists now, for she is in bondage with her children. ²⁶But the Jerusalem that is above is free, which is the mother of us all. ²⁷For it is written, "Rejoice, you barren who don't bear. Break out and shout, you who don't travail. For the desolate women have more children than her who has a husband." ²⁸Now we, brothers, as Isaac was, are children of promise. ²⁹But as then, he who was born according to the flesh persecuted him who was born according to the Spirit, so also it is now. ³⁰However, what does the Scripture say? "Throw out the servant and her son, for the son of the servant will not inherit with the son of the free woman." ³¹So then, brothers, we are not children of a servant, but of the free woman.

⁵Stand firm therefore in the liberty by which Messiah has made us free, and don't be entangled again with a yoke of bondage. ²Behold, I, Paul, tell you that if you receive circumcision, Messiah will profit you nothing. ³Yes, I testify again to every man who receives circumcision that he is a debtor to do the whole law. ⁴You are alienated from Messiah, you who desire to be justified by the law. You have fallen away from grace. ⁵For we through the Spirit, by faith wait for the hope of righteousness. ⁶For in Messiah Yeshua neither circumcision nor uncircumcision amounts to anything, but faith working through love. ⁷You were running well! Who interfered with you that you should not obey the truth? ⁸This persuasion is not from him who calls you. ⁹A little yeast grows through the whole lump.

¹⁰I have confidence toward you in the Lord that you will think no other way. But he who troubles you will bear his judgment, whoever he is. ¹¹But I, brothers, if I still proclaim circumcision, why am I still persecuted? Then the stumbling block of the cross has been removed. ¹²I wish that those who disturb you would cut themselves off. ¹³For you, brothers, were called for freedom. Only don't use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love be servants to one another. ¹⁴For the whole law is fulfilled in one word, in this: "You shall love your neighbor as yourself." ¹⁵But if you bite and devour one another, be careful that you don't consume one another. ¹⁶But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you won't fulfill the lust of the flesh. ¹⁷For the flesh lusts against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh; and these are contrary to one another, that you may not do the things that you desire. ¹⁸But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law. ¹⁹Now the deeds of the flesh are obvious, which are: adultery, sexual immorality, uncleanness, lustfulness, ²⁰idolatry, sorcery, hatred, strife, jealousies, outbursts of anger, rivalries, divisions, heresies, ²¹envy, murders, drunkenness, orgies, and things like these; of which I forewarn you, even as I also forewarned you, that those who practice such things will not inherit God's Kingdom. ²²But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, ^{ix} ²³gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law. ²⁴Those who belong to Messiah have crucified the flesh with its passions and lusts. ²⁵If we live by the Spirit, let's also walk by the Spirit. ²⁶Let's not become conceited, provoking one another, and envying one another.

⁶Brothers, even if a man is caught in some fault, you who are spiritual must restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness, looking to yourself so that you also aren't tempted. ²Bear one another's burdens, and so fulfill the Torah of Messiah. ³For if a man thinks himself to be something when he is nothing, he deceives himself. ⁴But let each man examine his own work, and then he will have reason to boast in himself, and not in someone else. ⁵For each man will bear his own burden. ⁶But let him who is taught in the word share all good things with him who teaches. ⁷Don't be deceived. God is not mocked, for whatever a man sows, that he will also reap. ⁸For he who sows to his own flesh will from the flesh reap corruption. But he who sows to the Spirit will from the Spirit reap eternal life. ⁹Let's not be weary in doing good, for we will reap in due season if we don't give up. ¹⁰So then, as we have opportunity, let's do what is good toward all men, and especially toward those who are of the household of the faith. ¹¹See with what large letters I write to you with my own hand. ¹²As many as desire to make a good impression in the flesh compel you to be circumcised, just so they may not be persecuted for the cross of Messiah.

^{ix}or, faithfulness

¹³For even they who receive circumcision don't keep the law themselves, but they desire to have you circumcised, so that they may boast in your flesh. ¹⁴But far be it from me to boast except in the cross of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. ¹⁵For in Messiah Yeshua neither is circumcision anything, nor uncircumcision, but a new creation. ¹⁶As many as walk by this rule, peace and mercy be on them, and on God's Israel. ¹⁷From now on, let no one cause me any trouble, for I bear the marks of the Lord Yeshua branded on my body. ¹⁸The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with your spirit, brothers. Amen.

Ephesians

¹Paul, an emissary of Messiah ⁱ Yeshua through the will of God, to the holy ones who are at Ephesus, and the faithful in Messiah Yeshua: ²Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ³Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, who has blessed us with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly places in Messiah, ⁴even as he chose us in him before the foundation of the world, that we would be holy and without defect before him in love, ⁵having predestined us for adoption as children through Yeshua the Messiah to himself, according to the good pleasure of his desire, ⁶to the praise of the glory of his grace, by which he freely gave us favor in the Beloved. ⁷In him we have our redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of his grace ⁸which he made to abound toward us in all wisdom and prudence, ⁹making known to us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he purposed in him ¹⁰to an administration of the fullness of the times, to sum up all things in Messiah, the things in the heavens and the things on the earth, in him. ¹¹We were also assigned an inheritance in him, having been foreordained according to the purpose of him who does all things after the counsel of his will, ¹²to the end that we should be to the praise of his glory, we who had before hoped in Messiah. ¹³In him you also, having heard the word of the truth, the Good News of your salvation—in whom, having also believed, you were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, ¹⁴who is a pledge of our inheritance, to the redemption of God's own possession, to the praise of his glory. ¹⁵For this cause I also, having heard of the faith in the Lord Yeshua which is among you and the love which you have toward all the holy ones, ¹⁶don't cease to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers, ¹⁷that the God of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, the Father of glory, may give to you a spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him, ¹⁸having the eyes of your hearts ⁱⁱ enlightened, that you may know what is the hope of his calling, and what are the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the holy ones, ¹⁹and what is the exceeding greatness of his power toward us who believe, according

to that working of the strength of his might ²⁰which he worked in Messiah when he raised him from the dead and made him to sit at his right hand in the heavenly places, ²¹far above all rule, authority, power, dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this age, but also in that which is to come. ²²He put all things in subjection under his feet, and gave him to be head over all things for the assembly, ²³which is his body, the fullness of him who fills all in all.

²You were made alive when you were dead in transgressions and sins, ²in which you once walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit who now works in the children of disobedience. ³We also all once lived among them in the lusts of our flesh, doing the desires of the flesh and of the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, even as the rest. ⁴But God, being rich in mercy, for his great love with which he loved us, ⁵even when we were dead through our trespasses, made us alive together with Messiah—by grace you have been saved— ⁶and raised us up with him, and made us to sit with him in the heavenly places in Messiah Yeshua, ⁷that in the ages to come he might show the exceeding riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Messiah Yeshua; ⁸for by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹not of works, that no one would boast. ¹⁰For we are his workmanship, created in Messiah Yeshua for good works, which God prepared before that we would walk in them. ¹¹Therefore remember that once you, the Gentiles in the flesh, who are called “uncircumcision” by that which is called “circumcision” (in the flesh, made by hands), ¹²that you were at that time separate from Messiah, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of the promise, having no hope and without God in the world. ¹³But now in Messiah Yeshua you who once were far off are made near in the blood of Messiah. ¹⁴For he is our peace, who made both one, and broke down the middle wall of separation, ¹⁵having abolished in his flesh the hostility, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, that he might create in himself one new man of the two, making peace, ¹⁶and might reconcile them both in one body to God through the cross, having killed the

ⁱ“Messiah” means “Anointed One”.

ⁱⁱTR reads “understanding” instead of “hearts”

hostility through it. ¹⁷He came and preached peace to you who were far off and to those who were near. ¹⁸For through him we both have our access in one Spirit to the Father. ¹⁹So then you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but you are fellow citizens with the holy ones and of the household of God, ²⁰being built on the foundation of the emissaries and prophets, Messiah Yeshua himself being the chief cornerstone; ²¹in whom the whole building, fitted together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord; ²²in whom you also are built together for a habitation of God in the Spirit.

3For this cause I, Paul, am the prisoner of Messiah Yeshua on behalf of you Gentiles, ²if it is so that you have heard of the administration of that grace of God which was given me toward you, ³how that by revelation the mystery was made known to me, as I wrote before in few words, ⁴by which, when you read, you can perceive my understanding in the mystery of Messiah, ⁵which in other generations was not made known to the children of men, as it has now been revealed to his holy emissaries and prophets in the Spirit, ⁶that the Gentiles are fellow heirs and fellow members of the body, and fellow partakers of his promise in Messiah Yeshua through the Good News, ⁷of which I was made a servant according to the gift of that grace of God which was given me according to the working of his power. ⁸To me, the very least of all holy ones, was this grace given, to proclaim to the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Messiah, ⁹and to make all men see what is the administration ⁱⁱⁱ of the mystery which for ages has been hidden in God, who created all things through Yeshua the Messiah, ¹⁰to the intent that now through the assembly the manifold wisdom of God might be made known to the principalities and the powers in the heavenly places, ¹¹according to the eternal purpose which he accomplished in Messiah Yeshua our Lord. ¹²In him we have boldness and access in confidence through our faith in him. ¹³Therefore I ask that you may not lose heart at my troubles for you, which are your glory. ¹⁴For this cause, I bow my knees to the Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ¹⁵from whom every family in heaven and on earth is named, ¹⁶that he would grant you, according to the riches of his glory, that you may be strengthened with power through his Spirit in the inner person, ¹⁷that Messiah may dwell in your hearts through faith, to the end that you, being rooted and grounded in love, ¹⁸may be strengthened to comprehend with all the holy ones what is the width and length and height and depth, ¹⁹and to know Messiah's love which surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God. ²⁰Now to him who is able to do exceedingly abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that works in us, ²¹to him be the glory in the assembly and in Messiah Yeshua to all generations, forever and ever. Amen.

4I therefore, the prisoner in the Lord, beg you to walk worthily of the calling with which you were called, ²with all lowliness and humility, with patience, bearing with one another in love, ³being eager to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace. ⁴There is one body and one Spirit, even as you also were called in one hope of your calling, ⁵one Lord, one faith, one immersion, ⁶one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in us all. ⁷But to each one of us, the grace was given according to the measure of the gift of Messiah. ⁸Therefore he says, "When he ascended on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts to people." ⁹Now this, "He ascended", what is it but that he also first descended into the lower parts of the earth? ¹⁰He who descended is the one who also ascended far above all the heavens, that he might fill all things. ¹¹He gave some to be emissaries; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, shepherds ^{iv} and teachers; ¹²for the perfecting of the holy ones, to the work of serving, to the building up of the body of Messiah, ¹³until we all attain to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a full grown man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Messiah, ¹⁴that we may no longer be children, tossed back and forth and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the trickery of men, in craftiness, after the wiles of error; ¹⁵but speaking truth in love, we may grow up in all things into him who is the head, Messiah, ¹⁶from whom all the body, being fitted and knit together through that which every joint supplies, according to the working in measure of each individual part, makes the body increase to the building up of itself in love. ¹⁷This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that you no longer walk as the rest of the Gentiles also walk, in the futility of their mind, ¹⁸being darkened in their understanding, alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them, because of the hardening of their hearts. ¹⁹They, having become callous, gave themselves up to lust, to work all uncleanness with greediness. ²⁰But you didn't learn Messiah that way, ²¹if indeed you heard him and were taught in him, even as truth is in Yeshua: ²²that you put away, as concerning your former way of life, the old man that grows corrupt after the lusts of deceit, ²³and that you be renewed in the spirit of your mind, ²⁴and put on the new man, who in the likeness of God has been created in righteousness and holiness of truth. ²⁵Therefore, putting away falsehood, speak truth each one with his neighbor, for we are members of one another. ²⁶"Be angry, and don't sin." Don't let the sun go down on your wrath, ²⁷and don't give place ^v to the devil. ²⁸Let him who stole steal no more; but rather let him labor, producing with his hands something that is good, that he may have something to give to him who has need. ²⁹Let no corrupt speech proceed out of your mouth, but only what is good for building others up as the need

ⁱⁱⁱTR reads "fellowship" instead of "administration"

^{iv}or, pastors

^vor, opportunity

may be, that it may give grace to those who hear. ³⁰Don't grieve the Holy Spirit of God, in whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. ³¹Let all bitterness, wrath, anger, outcry, and slander be put away from you, with all malice. ³²And be kind to one another, tender hearted, forgiving each other, just as God also in Messiah forgave you.

5Be therefore imitators of God, as beloved children. ²Walk in love, even as Messiah also loved us and gave himself up for us, an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweet-smelling fragrance. ³But sexual immorality, and all uncleanness or covetousness, let it not even be mentioned among you, as becomes holy ones; ⁴nor filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor jesting, which are not appropriate, but rather giving of thanks. ⁵Know this for sure, that no sexually immoral person, nor unclean person, nor covetous man (who is an idolater), has any inheritance in the Kingdom of Messiah and God. ⁶Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of these things the wrath of God comes on the children of disobedience. ⁷Therefore don't be partakers with them. ⁸For you were once darkness, but are now light in the Lord. Walk as children of light, ⁹for the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness and righteousness and truth, ¹⁰proving what is well pleasing to the Lord. ¹¹Have no fellowship with the unfruitful deeds of darkness, but rather even reprove them. ¹²For it is a shame even to speak of the things which are done by them in secret. ¹³But all things, when they are reproved, are revealed by the light, for everything that reveals is light. ¹⁴Therefore he says, "Awake, you who sleep, and arise from the dead, and Messiah will shine on you." ¹⁵Therefore watch carefully how you walk, not as unwise, but as wise, ¹⁶redeeming the time, because the days are evil. ¹⁷Therefore, don't be foolish, but understand what the will of the Lord is. ¹⁸Don't be drunken with wine, in which is dissipation, but be filled with the Spirit, ¹⁹speaking to one another in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs; singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord; ²⁰giving thanks always concerning all things in the name of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah to God, even the Father; ²¹submitting yourselves to one another in the fear of Messiah. ²²Wives, be subject to your own husbands, as to the Lord. ²³For the husband is the head of the wife, as Messiah also is the head of the assembly, being himself the savior of the body. ²⁴But as the assembly is subject to Messiah, so let the wives also be to their own husbands in everything. ²⁵Husbands, love your wives, even as Messiah also loved the assembly and gave himself up for her, ²⁶that he might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word, ²⁷that he might present the assembly to himself gloriously, not having spot or wrinkle or any such thing, but that she should be holy and without defect. ²⁸Even so husbands also ought to love their own wives as their own bodies. He who loves his own wife loves himself. ²⁹For no man ever

hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, even as the Lord also does the assembly, ³⁰because we are members of his body, of his flesh and bones. ³¹"For this cause a man will leave his father and mother and will be joined to his wife. Then the two will become one flesh." ³²This mystery is great, but I speak concerning Messiah and the assembly. ³³Nevertheless each of you must also love his own wife even as himself; and let the wife see that she respects her husband.

6Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right. ²"Honor your father and mother," which is the first commandment with a promise: ³"that it may be well with you, and you may live long on the earth." ⁴You fathers, don't provoke your children to wrath, but nurture them in the discipline and instruction of the Lord. ⁵Servants, be obedient to those who according to the flesh are your masters, with fear and trembling, in singleness of your heart, as to Messiah, ⁶not in the way of service only when eyes are on you, as men pleasers, but as servants of Messiah, doing the will of God from the heart, ⁷with good will doing service as to the Lord and not to men, ⁸knowing that whatever good thing each one does, he will receive the same good again from the Lord, whether he is bound or free. ⁹You masters, do the same things to them, and give up threatening, knowing that he who is both their Master and yours is in heaven, and there is no partiality with him. ¹⁰Finally, be strong in the Lord and in the strength of his might. ¹¹Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. ¹²For our wrestling is not against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world's rulers of the darkness of this age, and against the spiritual forces of wickedness in the heavenly places. ¹³Therefore put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. ¹⁴Stand therefore, having the utility belt of truth buckled around your waist, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, ¹⁵and having fitted your feet with the preparation of the Good News of peace, ¹⁶above all, taking up the shield of faith, with which you will be able to quench all the fiery darts of the evil one. ¹⁷And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word ^{vi}of God; ¹⁸with all prayer and requests, praying at all times in the Spirit, and being watchful to this end in all perseverance and requests for all the holy ones. ¹⁹Pray for me, that utterance may be given to me in opening my mouth, to make known with boldness the mystery of the Good News, ²⁰for which I am an ambassador in chains; that in it I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak. ²¹But that you also may know my affairs, how I am doing, Tychicus, the beloved brother and faithful servant in the Lord, will make known to you all things. ²²I have sent him to you for this

^{vi}from the Greek " " (rhema), which means "spoken word"

very purpose, that you may know our state and that he may comfort your hearts. ²³Peace be to the brothers, and love with faith, from God the Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ²⁴Grace be with all those who love our Lord Yeshua the Messiah with incorruptible love. Amen.

Philippians

¹Paul and Timothy, servants of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ to all the holy ones in Messiah Yeshua who are at Philippi, with the overseers ⁱⁱ and servants: ⁱⁱⁱ ²Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ³I thank my God whenever I remember you, ⁴always in every request of mine on behalf of you all, making my requests with joy, ⁵for your partnership ^{iv} in furtherance of the Good News from the first day until now; ⁶being confident of this very thing, that he who began a good work in you will complete it until the day of Yeshua the Messiah. ⁷It is even right for me to think this way on behalf of all of you, because I have you in my heart, because both in my bonds and in the defense and confirmation of the Good News, you all are partakers with me of grace. ⁸For God is my witness, how I long after all of you in the tender mercies of Messiah Yeshua. ⁹This I pray, that your love may abound yet more and more in knowledge and all discernment, ¹⁰so that you may approve the things that are excellent, that you may be sincere and without offense to the day of Messiah, ¹¹being filled with the fruits of righteousness which are through Yeshua the Messiah, to the glory and praise of God. ¹²Now I desire to have you know, brothers, ^v that the things which happened to me have turned out rather to the progress of the Good News, ¹³so that it became evident to the whole palace ^{vi} guard, and to all the rest, that my bonds are in Messiah, ¹⁴and that most of the brothers in the Lord, being confident through my bonds, are more abundantly bold to speak the word of God without fear. ¹⁵Some indeed proclaim Messiah even out of envy and strife, and some also out of good will. ¹⁶The former insincerely proclaim Messiah from selfish ambition, thinking that they add affliction to my chains; ¹⁷but the latter out of love, knowing that I am appointed for the defense of the Good News. ¹⁸What does it matter? Only that in every way, whether in pretense or in truth, Messiah

is proclaimed. I rejoice in this, yes, and will rejoice. ¹⁹For I know that this will turn out to my salvation through your prayers and the supply of the Spirit of Yeshua the Messiah, ²⁰according to my earnest expectation and hope, that I will in no way be disappointed, but with all boldness, as always, now also Messiah will be magnified in my body, whether by life or by death. ²¹For to me to live is Messiah, and to die is gain. ²²But if I live on in the flesh, this will bring fruit from my work; yet I don't know what I will choose. ²³But I am hard pressed between the two, having the desire to depart and be with Messiah, which is far better. ²⁴Yet to remain in the flesh is more needful for your sake. ²⁵Having this confidence, I know that I will remain, yes, and remain with you all for your progress and joy in the faith, ²⁶that your boasting ^{vii} may abound in Messiah Yeshua in me through my presence with you again. ²⁷Only let your way of life be worthy of the Good News of Messiah, that whether I come and see you or am absent, I may hear of your state, that you stand firm in one spirit, with one soul striving for the faith of the Good News; ²⁸and in nothing frightened by the adversaries, which is for them a proof of destruction, but to you of salvation, and that from God. ²⁹Because it has been granted to you on behalf of Messiah, not only to believe in him, but also to suffer on his behalf, ³⁰having the same conflict which you saw in me and now hear is in me.

²If therefore there is any exhortation in Messiah, if any consolation of love, if any fellowship of the Spirit, if any tender mercies and compassion, ²make my joy full by being like-minded, having the same love, being of one accord, of one mind; ³doing nothing through rivalry or through conceit, but in humility, each counting others better than himself; ⁴each of you not just looking to his own things, but each of you also to the things of others. ⁵Have this in your mind, which was also in Messiah Yeshua, ⁶who, existing in the form of God, didn't consider equality with God a thing to be grasped, ⁷but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men. ⁸And being found in human form, he humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, yes, the death of the cross.

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱor, superintendents, or bishops

ⁱⁱⁱOr, shammashim

^{iv}The word translated "partnership" () also means "fellowship" and "sharing".

^vThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

^{vi}or, praetorian

^{vii}or, rejoicing

⁹Therefore God also highly exalted him, and gave to him the name which is above every name, ¹⁰that at the name of Yeshua every knee should bow, of those in heaven, those on earth, and those under the earth, ¹¹and that every tongue should confess that Yeshua the Messiah is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. ¹²So then, my beloved, even as you have always obeyed, not only in my presence, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling. ¹³For it is God who works in you both to will and to work for his good pleasure. ¹⁴Do all things without complaining and arguing, ¹⁵that you may become blameless and harmless, children of God without defect in the middle of a crooked and perverse generation, among whom you are seen as lights in the world, ¹⁶holding up the word of life, that I may have something to boast in the day of Messiah that I didn't run in vain nor labor in vain. ¹⁷Yes, and if I am poured out on the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am glad and rejoice with you all. ¹⁸In the same way, you also should be glad and rejoice with me. ¹⁹But I hope in the Lord Yeshua to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered up when I know how you are doing. ²⁰For I have no one else like-minded, who will truly care about you. ²¹For they all seek their own, not the things of Yeshua the Messiah. ²²But you know that he has proved himself. As a child serves a father, so he served with me in furtherance of the Good News. ²³Therefore I hope to send him at once, as soon as I see how it will go with me. ²⁴But I trust in the Lord that I myself also will come shortly. ²⁵But I thought it necessary to send to you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow worker, fellow soldier, and your emissary and servant of my need, ²⁶since he longed for you all, and was very troubled because you had heard that he was sick. ²⁷For indeed he was sick nearly to death, but God had mercy on him, and not on him only, but on me also, that I might not have sorrow on sorrow. ²⁸I have sent him therefore the more diligently, that when you see him again, you may rejoice, and that I may be the less sorrowful. ²⁹Receive him therefore in the Lord with all joy, and hold such people in honor, ³⁰because for the work of Messiah he came near to death, risking his life to supply that which was lacking in your service toward me.

3Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord! To write the same things to you, to me indeed is not tiresome, but for you it is safe. ²Beware of the dogs; beware of the evil workers; beware of the false circumcision. ³For we are the circumcision, who worship God in the Spirit, and rejoice in Messiah Yeshua, and have no confidence in the flesh; ⁴though I myself might have confidence even in the flesh. If any other man thinks that he has confidence in the flesh, I yet more: ⁵circumcised the eighth day, of the stock of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Hebrew of Hebrews; concerning the law, a Pharisee; ⁶concerning zeal, persecuting the assembly; concerning the righteousness which is

in the law, found blameless. ⁷However, I consider those things that were gain to me as a loss for Messiah. ⁸Yes most certainly, and I count all things to be a loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Messiah Yeshua, my Lord, for whom I suffered the loss of all things, and count them nothing but refuse, that I may gain Messiah ⁹and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own, that which is of the law, but that which is through faith in Messiah, the righteousness which is from God by faith, ¹⁰that I may know him and the power of his resurrection, and the fellowship of his sufferings, becoming conformed to his death, ¹¹if by any means I may attain to the resurrection from the dead. ¹²Not that I have already obtained, or am already made perfect; but I press on, that I may take hold of that for which also I was taken hold of by Messiah Yeshua. ¹³Brothers, I don't regard myself as yet having taken hold, but one thing I do: forgetting the things which are behind and stretching forward to the things which are before, ¹⁴I press on toward the goal for the prize of the high calling of God in Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁵Let us therefore, as many as are perfect, think this way. If in anything you think otherwise, God will also reveal that to you. ¹⁶Nevertheless, to the extent that we have already attained, let's walk by the same rule. Let's be of the same mind. ¹⁷Brothers, be imitators together of me, and note those who walk this way, even as you have us for an example. ¹⁸For many walk, of whom I told you often, and now tell you even weeping, as the enemies of the cross of Messiah, ¹⁹whose end is destruction, whose god is the belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who think about earthly things. ²⁰For our citizenship is in heaven, from where we also wait for a Savior, the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ²¹who will change the body of our humiliation to be conformed to the body of his glory, according to the working by which he is able even to subject all things to himself.

4Therefore, my brothers, beloved and longed for, my joy and crown, stand firm in the Lord in this way, my beloved. ²I exhort Euodia, and I exhort Syntyche, to think the same way in the Lord. ³Yes, I beg you also, true partner, help these women, for they labored with me in the Good News with Clement also, and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the book of life. ⁴Rejoice in the Lord always! Again I will say, "Rejoice!" ⁵Let your gentleness be known to all men. The Lord is at hand. ⁶In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. ⁷And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your thoughts in Messiah Yeshua. ⁸Finally, brothers, whatever things are true, whatever things are honorable, whatever things are just, whatever things are pure, whatever things are lovely, whatever things are of good report: if there is any virtue and if there is anything worthy of praise, think about these

things. ⁹Do the things which you learned, received, heard, and saw in me, and the God of peace will be with you. ¹⁰But I rejoice in the Lord greatly that now at length you have revived your thought for me; in which you did indeed take thought, but you lacked opportunity. ¹¹Not that I speak because of lack, for I have learned in whatever state I am, to be content in it. ¹²I know how to be humbled, and I also know how to abound. In any and all circumstances I have learned the secret both to be filled and to be hungry, both to abound and to be in need. ¹³I can do all things through Messiah who strengthens me. ¹⁴However you did well that you shared in my affliction. ¹⁵You yourselves also know, you Philippians, that in the beginning of the Good News, when I departed from Macedonia, no assembly shared with me in the matter of giving and receiving but you only. ¹⁶For even in Thessalonica you sent once and again to my need. ¹⁷Not that I seek for the gift, but I seek for the fruit that increases to your account. ¹⁸But I have all things and abound. I am filled, having received from Epaphroditus the things that came from you, a sweet-smelling fragrance, an acceptable and well-pleasing sacrifice to God. ¹⁹My God will supply every need of yours according to his riches in glory in Messiah Yeshua. ²⁰Now to our God and Father be the glory forever and ever! Amen. ²¹Greet every holy one in Messiah Yeshua. The brothers who are with me greet you. ²²All the holy ones greet you, especially those who are of Caesar's household. ²³The grace of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you all. Amen.

Colossians

¹Paul, an emissary of Messiah ⁱ Yeshua through the will of God, and Timothy our brother, ²to the holy ones and faithful brothers ⁱⁱ in Messiah at Colossae: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ³We give thanks to God the Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, praying always for you, ⁴having heard of your faith in Messiah Yeshua and of the love which you have toward all the holy ones, ⁵because of the hope which is laid up for you in the heavens, of which you heard before in the word of the truth of the Good News ⁶which has come to you, even as it is in all the world and is bearing fruit and growing, as it does in you also, since the day you heard and knew the grace of God in truth, ⁷even as you learned from Epaphras our beloved fellow servant, who is a faithful servant of Messiah on your ⁱⁱⁱ behalf, ⁸who also declared to us your love in the Spirit. ⁹For this cause, we also, since the day we heard this, don't cease praying and making requests for you, that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, ¹⁰that you may walk worthily of the Lord, to please him in all respects, bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the knowledge of God, ¹¹strengthened with all power, according to the might of his glory, for all endurance and perseverance with joy, ¹²giving thanks to the Father, who made us fit to be partakers of the inheritance of the holy ones in light, ¹³who delivered us out of the power of darkness, and translated us into the Kingdom of the Son of his love, ¹⁴in whom we have our redemption, ^{iv} the forgiveness of our sins. ¹⁵He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. ¹⁶For by him all things were created in the heavens and on the earth, visible things and invisible things, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things have been created through him and for him. ¹⁷He is before all things, and in him all things are held together. ¹⁸He is the head of the body, the assembly, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things he might have the preeminence. ¹⁹For all the fullness was pleased to dwell in him,

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

ⁱⁱⁱNU reads

^{iv}TR adds "through his blood,"

²⁰and through him to reconcile all things to himself by him, whether things on the earth or things in the heavens, having made peace through the blood of his cross. ²¹You, being in past times alienated and enemies in your mind in your evil deeds, ²²yet now he has reconciled in the body of his flesh through death, to present you holy and without defect and blameless before him, ²³if it is so that you continue in the faith, grounded and steadfast, and not moved away from the hope of the Good News which you heard, which is being proclaimed in all creation under heaven, of which I, Paul, was made a servant. ²⁴Now I rejoice in my sufferings for your sake, and fill up on my part that which is lacking of the afflictions of Messiah in my flesh for his body's sake, which is the assembly, ²⁵of which I was made a servant according to the stewardship of God which was given me toward you to fulfill the word of God, ²⁶the mystery which has been hidden for ages and generations. But now it has been revealed to his holy ones, ²⁷to whom God was pleased to make known what are the riches of the glory of this mystery among the Gentiles, which is Messiah in you, the hope of glory. ²⁸We proclaim him, admonishing every man and teaching every man in all wisdom, that we may present every man perfect in Messiah Yeshua; ²⁹for which I also labor, striving according to his working, which works in me mightily.

²For I desire to have you know how greatly I struggle for you and for those at Laodicea, and for as many as have not seen my face in the flesh; ²that their hearts may be comforted, they being knit together in love, and gaining all riches of the full assurance of understanding, that they may know the mystery of God, both of the Father and of Messiah, ³in whom all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge are hidden. ⁴Now I say this that no one may delude you with persuasiveness of speech. ⁵For though I am absent in the flesh, yet I am with you in the spirit, rejoicing and seeing your order, and the steadfastness of your faith in Messiah. ⁶As therefore you received Messiah Yeshua the Lord, walk in him, ⁷rooted and built up in him and established in the faith, even as you were taught, abounding in it in thanksgiving. ⁸Be careful that you don't let anyone rob you through his philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the elemental spirits of the world,

and not after Messiah. ⁹For in him all the fullness of the Deity dwells bodily, ¹⁰and in him you are made full, who is the head of all principality and power. ¹¹In him you were also circumcised with a circumcision not made with hands, in the putting off of the body of the sins of the flesh, in the circumcision of Messiah, ¹²having been buried with him in immersion, in which you were also raised with him through faith in the working of God, who raised him from the dead. ¹³You were dead through your trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh. He made you alive together with him, having forgiven us all our trespasses, ¹⁴wiping out the handwriting in ordinances which was against us. He has taken it out of the way, nailing it to the cross. ¹⁵Having stripped the principalities and the powers, he made a show of them openly, triumphing over them in it. ¹⁶Let no one therefore judge you in eating or drinking, or with respect to a feast day or a new moon or a Sabbath day, ¹⁷which are a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Messiah's. ¹⁸Let no one rob you of your prize by self-abasement and worshiping of the angels, dwelling in the things which he has not seen, vainly puffed up by his fleshly mind, ¹⁹and not holding firmly to the Head, from whom all the body, being supplied and knit together through the joints and ligaments, grows with God's growth. ²⁰If you died with Messiah from the elemental spirits of the world, why, as though living in the world, do you subject yourselves to ordinances, ²¹"Don't handle, nor taste, nor touch" ²²(all of which perish with use), according to the precepts and doctrines of men? ²³These things indeed appear like wisdom in self-imposed worship, humility, and severity to the body, but aren't of any value against the indulgence of the flesh.

³If then you were raised together with Messiah, seek the things that are above, where Messiah is, seated on the right hand of God. ²Set your mind on the things that are above, not on the things that are on the earth. ³For you died, and your life is hidden with Messiah in God. ⁴When Messiah, our life, is revealed, then you will also be revealed with him in glory. ⁵Put to death therefore your members which are on the earth: sexual immorality, uncleanness, depraved passion, evil desire, and covetousness, which is idolatry. ⁶For these things' sake the wrath of God comes on the children of disobedience. ⁷You also once walked in those, when you lived in them, ⁸but now you must put them all away: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and shameful speaking out of your mouth. ⁹Don't lie to one another, seeing that you have put off the old man with his doings, ¹⁰and have put on the new man, who is being renewed in knowledge after the image of his Creator, ¹¹where there can't be Greek and Jew, circumcision and uncircumcision, barbarian, Scythian, bondservant, or free person; but Messiah is all, and in all. ¹²Put on therefore, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, a heart of compassion, kindness,

lowliness, humility, and perseverance; ¹³bearing with one another, and forgiving each other, if any man has a complaint against any; even as Messiah forgave you, so you also do. ¹⁴Above all these things, walk in love, which is the bond of perfection. ¹⁵And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to which also you were called in one body, and be thankful. ¹⁶Let the word of Messiah dwell in you richly; in all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your heart to the Lord. ¹⁷Whatever you do, in word or in deed, do all in the name of the Lord Yeshua, giving thanks to God the Father through him. ¹⁸Wives, be in subjection to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord. ¹⁹Husbands, love your wives, and don't be bitter against them. ²⁰Children, obey your parents in all things, for this pleases the Lord. ²¹Fathers, don't provoke your children, so that they won't be discouraged. ²²Servants, obey in all things those who are your masters according to the flesh, not just when they are looking, as men pleasers, but in singleness of heart, fearing God. ²³And whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men, ²⁴knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Messiah. ²⁵But he who does wrong will receive again for the wrong that he has done, and there is no partiality.

⁴Masters, give to your servants that which is just and equal, knowing that you also have a Master in heaven. ²Continue steadfastly in prayer, watching in it with thanksgiving, ³praying together for us also, that God may open to us a door for the word, to speak the mystery of Messiah, for which I am also in bonds, ⁴that I may reveal it as I ought to speak. ⁵Walk in wisdom toward those who are outside, redeeming the time. ⁶Let your speech always be with grace, seasoned with salt, that you may know how you ought to answer each one. ⁷All my affairs will be made known to you by Tychicus, the beloved brother, faithful servant, and fellow bondservant in the Lord. ⁸I am sending him to you for this very purpose, that he may know your circumstances and comfort your hearts, ⁹together with Onesimus, the faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They will make known to you everything that is going on here. ¹⁰Aristarchus, my fellow prisoner, greets you, and Mark the cousin of Barnabas (concerning whom you received instructions, "if he comes to you, receive him"), ¹¹and Yeshua who is called Justus. These are my only fellow workers for God's Kingdom who are of the circumcision, men who have been a comfort to me. ¹²Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Messiah, salutes you, always striving for you in his prayers, that you may stand perfect and complete in all the will of God. ¹³For I testify about him that he has great zeal for you, and for those in Laodicea, and for those in Hierapolis. ¹⁴Luke the beloved physician and Demas greet you. ¹⁵Greet the brothers who are in

Laodicea, with Nymphas and the assembly that is in his house. ¹⁶When this letter has been read among you, cause it to be read also in the assembly of the Laodiceans, and that you also read the letter from Laodicea. ¹⁷Tell Archipus, "Take heed to the ministry which you have received in the Lord, that you fulfill it." ¹⁸I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand. Remember my chains. Grace be with you. Amen.

1 Thessalonians

¹Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy, to the assembly of the Thessalonians in God the Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah: ⁱ Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ²We always give thanks to God for all of you, mentioning you in our prayers, ³remembering without ceasing your work of faith and labor of love and perseverance of hope in our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, before our God and Father. ⁴We know, brothers ⁱⁱ loved by God, that you are chosen, ⁵and that our Good News came to you not in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Spirit and with much assurance. You know what kind of men we showed ourselves to be among you for your sake. ⁶You became imitators of us and of the Lord, having received the word in much affliction, with joy of the Holy Spirit, ⁷so that you became an example to all who believe in Macedonia and in Achaia. ⁸For from you the word of the Lord has been declared, not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but also in every place your faith toward God has gone out, so that we need not to say anything. ⁹For they themselves report concerning us what kind of a reception we had from you, and how you turned to God from idols to serve a living and true God, ¹⁰and to wait for his Son from heaven, whom he raised from the dead: Yeshua, who delivers us from the wrath to come.

²For you yourselves know, brothers, our visit to you wasn't in vain, ²but having suffered before and been shamefully treated, as you know, at Philippi, we grew bold in our God to tell you the Good News of God in much conflict. ³For our exhortation is not of error, nor of uncleanness, nor in deception. ⁴But even as we have been approved by God to be entrusted with the Good News, so we speak—not as pleasing men, but God, who tests our hearts. ⁵For neither were we at any time found using words of flattery, as you know, nor a cloak of covetousness (God is witness), ⁶nor seeking glory from men (neither from you nor from others), when we might have claimed authority as emissaries of Messiah. ⁷But we were gentle among you, like a nursing mother cherishes her own children. ⁸Even so,

affectionately longing for you, we were well pleased to impart to you not the Good News of God only, but also our own souls, because you had become very dear to us. ⁹For you remember, brothers, our labor and travail; for working night and day, that we might not burden any of you, we preached to you the Good News of God. ¹⁰You are witnesses with God how holy, righteously, and blamelessly we behaved ourselves toward you who believe. ¹¹As you know, we exhorted, comforted, and implored every one of you, as a father does his own children, ¹²to the end that you should walk worthily of God, who calls you into his own Kingdom and glory. ¹³For this cause we also thank God without ceasing that when you received from us the word of the message of God, you accepted it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, God's word, which also works in you who believe. ¹⁴For you, brothers, became imitators of the assemblies of God which are in Judea in Messiah Yeshua; for you also suffered the same things from your own countrymen, even as they did from the Judeans ¹⁵who killed both the Lord Yeshua and their own prophets, and drove us out, and don't please God, and are contrary to all men, ¹⁶forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles that they may be saved, to fill up their sins always. But wrath has come on them to the uttermost. ¹⁷But we, brothers, being bereaved of you for a short season in presence, not in heart, tried even harder to see your face with great desire, ¹⁸because we wanted to come to you—indeed, I, Paul, once and again—but Satan hindered us. ¹⁹For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? Isn't it even you, before our Lord Yeshua ⁱⁱⁱ at his coming? ²⁰For you are our glory and our joy.

³Therefore when we couldn't stand it any longer, we thought it good to be left behind at Athens alone, ²and sent Timothy, our brother and God's servant in the Good News of Messiah, to establish you and to comfort you concerning your faith, ³that no one would be moved by these afflictions. For you know that we are appointed to this task. ⁴For most certainly, when we were with you, we told you beforehand that we are to suffer affliction, even as it happened, and you know. ⁵For this cause I also, when I

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

ⁱⁱⁱTR adds "Messiah"

couldn't stand it any longer, sent that I might know your faith, for fear that by any means the tempter had tempted you, and our labor would have been in vain. ⁶But Timothy has just now come to us from you, and brought us glad news of your faith and love, and that you have good memories of us always, longing to see us, even as we also long to see you. ⁷For this cause, brothers, we were comforted over you in all our distress and affliction through your faith. ⁸For now we live, if you stand fast in the Lord. ⁹For what thanksgiving can we render again to God for you, for all the joy with which we rejoice for your sakes before our God, ¹⁰night and day praying exceedingly that we may see your face and may perfect that which is lacking in your faith? ¹¹Now may our God and Father himself, and our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, direct our way to you. ¹²May the Lord make you to increase and abound in love toward one another and toward all men, even as we also do toward you, ¹³to the end he may establish your hearts blameless in holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Yeshua with all his holy ones.

⁴Finally then, brothers, we beg and exhort you in the Lord Yeshua, that as you received from us how you ought to walk and to please God, that you abound more and more. ²For you know what instructions we gave you through the Lord Yeshua. ³For this is the will of God: your sanctification, that you abstain from sexual immorality, ⁴that each one of you know how to control his own body ^{iv} in sanctification and honor, ⁵not in the passion of lust, even as the Gentiles who don't know God, ⁶that no one should take advantage of and wrong a brother or sister in this matter; because the Lord is an avenger in all these things, as also we forewarned you and testified. ⁷For God called us not for uncleanness, but in sanctification. ⁸Therefore he who rejects this doesn't reject man, but God, who has also given his Holy Spirit to you. ⁹But concerning brotherly love, you have no need that one write to you. For you yourselves are taught by God to love one another, ¹⁰for indeed you do it toward all the brothers who are in all Macedonia. But we exhort you, brothers, that you abound more and more; ¹¹and that you make it your ambition to lead a quiet life, and to do your own business, and to work with your own hands, even as we instructed you, ¹²that you may walk properly toward those who are outside, and may have need of nothing. ¹³But we don't want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning those who have fallen asleep, so that you don't grieve like the rest, who have no hope. ¹⁴For if we believe that Yeshua died and rose again, even so God will bring with him those who have fallen asleep in Yeshua. ¹⁵For this we tell you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, will in no way precede those who have fallen asleep. ¹⁶For the Lord himself will descend from heaven

with a shout, with the voice of the archangel and with God's shofar. The dead in Messiah will rise first, ¹⁷then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. So we will be with the Lord forever. ¹⁸Therefore comfort one another with these words.

⁵But concerning the times and the seasons, brothers, you have no need that anything be written to you. ²For you yourselves know well that the day of the Lord comes like a thief in the night. ³For when they are saying, "Peace and safety," then sudden destruction will come on them, like birth pains on a pregnant woman. Then they will in no way escape. ⁴But you, brothers, aren't in darkness, that the day should overtake you like a thief. ⁵You are all children of light and children of the day. We don't belong to the night, nor to darkness, ⁶so then let's not sleep, as the rest do, but let's watch and be sober. ⁷For those who sleep, sleep in the night; and those who are drunk are drunk in the night. ⁸But since we belong to the day, let's be sober, putting on the breastplate of faith and love, and for a helmet, the hope of salvation. ⁹For God didn't appoint us to wrath, but to the obtaining of salvation through our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ¹⁰who died for us, that, whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with him. ¹¹Therefore exhort one another, and build each other up, even as you also do. ¹²But we beg you, brothers, to know those who labor among you, and are over you in the Lord and admonish you, ¹³and to respect and honor them in love for their work's sake. Be at peace among yourselves. ¹⁴We exhort you, brothers: Admonish the disorderly; encourage the faint-hearted; support the weak; be patient toward all. ¹⁵See that no one returns evil for evil to anyone, but always follow after that which is good for one another and for all. ¹⁶Always rejoice. ¹⁷Pray without ceasing. ¹⁸In everything give thanks, for this is the will of God in Messiah Yeshua toward you. ¹⁹Don't quench the Spirit. ²⁰Don't despise prophecies. ²¹Test all things, and hold firmly that which is good. ²²Abstain from every form of evil. ²³May the God of peace himself sanctify you completely. May your whole spirit, soul, and body be preserved blameless at the coming of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ²⁴He who calls you is faithful, who will also do it. ²⁵Brothers, pray for us. ²⁶Greet all the brothers with a holy kiss. ²⁷I solemnly command you by the Lord that this letter be read to all the holy brothers. ²⁸The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you. Amen.

^{iv}literally, possess his own vessel

2 Thessalonians

¹Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy, to the assembly of the Thessalonians in God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah: ²Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ³We are bound to always give thanks to God for you, brothers,ⁱ even as it is appropriate, because your faith grows exceedingly, and the love of each and every one of you toward one another abounds,⁴ so that we ourselves boast about you in the assemblies of God for your perseverance and faith in all your persecutions and in the afflictions which you endure. ⁵This is an obvious sign of the righteous judgment of God, to the end that you may be counted worthy of God's Kingdom, for which you also suffer. ⁶For it is a righteous thing with God to repay affliction to those who afflict you,⁷ and to give relief to you who are afflicted with us when the Lord Yeshua is revealed from heaven with his mighty angels in flaming fire,⁸ punishing those who don't know God, and to those who don't obey the Good News of our Lord Yeshua,⁹ who will pay the penalty: eternal destruction from the face of the Lord and from the glory of his might,¹⁰ when he comes in that day to be glorified in his holy ones and to be admired among all those who have believed, because our testimony to you was believed. ¹¹To this end we also pray always for you that our God may count you worthy of your calling, and fulfill every desire of goodness and work of faith with power,¹² that the name of our Lord Yeshuaⁱⁱ may be glorified in you, and you in him, according to the grace of our God and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah.

²Now, brothers, concerning the coming of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah and our gathering together to him, we ask you² not to be quickly shaken in your mind or troubled, either by spirit or by word or by letter as if from us, saying that the day of Messiah has already come. ³Let no one deceive you in any way. For it will not be unless the rebellionⁱⁱⁱ comes first, and the man of sin is revealed, the son of destruction. ⁴He opposes and exalts himself against all that is called God or that is worshiped, so that he sits as God in the temple of God, setting himself up as God.

ⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

ⁱⁱTR adds "Messiah"

ⁱⁱⁱor,

⁵Don't you remember that when I was still with you, I told you these things? ⁶Now you know what is restraining him, to the end that he may be revealed in his own season. ⁷For the mystery of lawlessness already works. Only there is one who restrains now, until he is taken out of the way. ⁸Then the lawless one will be revealed, whom the Lord will kill with the breath of his mouth and destroy by the manifestation of his coming; ⁹even he whose coming is according to the working of Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders,¹⁰ and with all deception of wickedness for those who are being lost, because they didn't receive the love of the truth, that they might be saved. ¹¹Because of this, God sends them a powerful delusion, that they should believe a lie,¹² that they all might be judged who didn't believe the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness. ¹³But we are bound to always give thanks to God for you, brothers loved by the Lord, because God chose you from the beginning for salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief in the truth,¹⁴ to which he called you through our Good News, for the obtaining of the glory of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁵So then, brothers, stand firm and hold the traditions which you were taught by us, whether by word or by letter. ¹⁶Now our Lord Yeshua the Messiah himself, and God our Father, who loved us and gave us eternal comfort and good hope through grace,¹⁷ comfort your hearts and establish you in every good work and word.

³Finally, brothers, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may spread rapidly and be glorified, even as also with you,² and that we may be delivered from unreasonable and evil men; for not all have faith. ³But the Lord is faithful, who will establish you and guard you from the evil one. ⁴We have confidence in the Lord concerning you, that you both do and will do the things we command. ⁵May the Lord direct your hearts into God's love and into the perseverance of Messiah. ⁶Now we command you, brothers, in the name of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, that you withdraw yourselves from every brother who walks in rebellion and not after the tradition which they received from us. ⁷For you know how you ought to imitate us. For we didn't behave ourselves rebelliously among you,⁸ neither did we eat bread from anyone's hand without paying for it, but in

labor and travail worked night and day, that we might not burden any of you. ⁹This was not because we don't have the right, but to make ourselves an example to you, that you should imitate us. ¹⁰For even when we were with you, we commanded you this: "If anyone is not willing to work, don't let him eat." ¹¹For we hear of some who walk among you in rebellion, who don't work at all, but are busybodies. ¹²Now those who are that way, we command and exhort in the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, that they work with quietness and eat their own bread. ¹³But you, brothers, don't be weary in doing what is right. ¹⁴If any man doesn't obey our word in this letter, note that man and have no company with him, to the end that he may be ashamed. ¹⁵Don't count him as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother. ¹⁶Now may the Lord of peace himself give you peace at all times in all ways. The Lord be with you all. ¹⁷I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand, which is the sign in every letter. This is how I write. ¹⁸The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with you all. Amen.

1 Timothy

¹Paul, an emissary of Yeshua the Messiah according to the commandment of God our Savior and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah ⁱ our hope, ²to Timothy, my true child in faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God our Father and Messiah Yeshua our Lord. ³As I urged you when I was going into Macedonia, stay at Ephesus that you might command certain men not to teach a different doctrine, ⁴and not to pay attention to myths and endless genealogies, which cause disputes rather than God's stewardship, which is in faith. ⁵But the goal of this command is love from a pure heart, a good conscience, and sincere faith, ⁶from which things some, having missed the mark, have turned away to vain talking, ⁷desiring to be teachers of the law, though they understand neither what they say nor about what they strongly affirm. ⁸But we know that the law is good if a person uses it lawfully, ⁹as knowing this, that law is not made for a righteous person, but for the lawless and insubordinate, for the ungodly and sinners, for the unholy and profane, for murderers of fathers and murderers of mothers, for manslayers, ¹⁰for the sexually immoral, for homosexuals, for slave-traders, for liars, for perjurers, and for any other thing contrary to the sound doctrine, ¹¹according to the Good News of the glory of the blessed God, which was committed to my trust. ¹²I thank him who enabled me, Messiah Yeshua our Lord, because he counted me faithful, appointing me to service, ¹³although I used to be a blasphemer, a persecutor, and insolent. However, I obtained mercy because I did it ignorantly in unbelief. ¹⁴The grace of our Lord abounded exceedingly with faith and love which is in Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁵The saying is faithful and worthy of all acceptance, that Messiah Yeshua came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am chief. ¹⁶However, for this cause I obtained mercy, that in me first, Yeshua the Messiah might display all his patience for an example of those who were going to believe in him for eternal life. ¹⁷Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, to God who alone is wise, be honor and glory forever and ever. Amen. ¹⁸I commit this instruction to you, my child Timothy, according to the prophecies which were given to you before, that by them you may wage the good warfare, ¹⁹holding faith and a good conscience, which some having

thrust away made a shipwreck concerning the faith, ²⁰of whom are Hymenaeus and Alexander, whom I delivered to Satan that they might be taught not to blaspheme.

²I exhort therefore, first of all, that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and givings of thanks be made for all men, ²for kings and all who are in high places, that we may lead a tranquil and quiet life in all godliness and reverence. ³For this is good and acceptable in the sight of God our Savior, ⁴who desires all people to be saved and come to full knowledge of the truth. ⁵For there is one God and one mediator between God and men, the man Messiah Yeshua, ⁶who gave himself as a ransom for all, the testimony at the proper time, ⁷to which I was appointed a proclaimer and an emissary—I am telling the truth in Messiah, not lying—a teacher of the Gentiles in faith and truth. ⁸I desire therefore that the men in every place pray, lifting up holy hands without anger and doubting. ⁹In the same way, that women also adorn themselves in decent clothing, with modesty and propriety, not ⁱⁱ with braided hair, gold, pearls, or expensive clothing, ¹⁰but with good works, which is appropriate for women professing godliness. ¹¹Let a woman learn in quietness with full submission. ¹²But I don't permit a woman to teach, nor to exercise authority over a man, but to be in quietness. ¹³For Adam was formed first, then Havah. ¹⁴Adam wasn't deceived, but the woman, being deceived, has fallen into disobedience; ¹⁵but she will be saved through her childbearing, if they continue in faith, love, and holiness with sobriety.

³This is a faithful saying: someone who seeks to be an overseer ⁱⁱⁱ desires a good work. ²The overseer therefore must be without reproach, the husband of one wife, temperate, sensible, modest, hospitable, good at teaching; ³not a drinker, not violent, not greedy for money, but gentle, not quarrelsome, not covetous; ⁴one who rules his own house well, having children in subjection with all reverence; ⁵(for how could someone who doesn't know how to

ⁱNU reads

ⁱⁱThe word for "not" is the negative particle " " which denies an expected idea, as opposed to the usual word for "not" () which denies a fact. Thus " " in this context is denying an expected idea (that women can be properly dressed without good works).

ⁱⁱⁱor, superintendent, or bishop

rule his own house take care of God's assembly?) ⁶not a new convert, lest being puffed up he fall into the same condemnation as the devil. ⁷Moreover he must have good testimony from those who are outside, to avoid falling into reproach and the snare of the devil. ⁸Servants, ^{iv} in the same way, must be reverent, not double-tongued, not addicted to much wine, not greedy for money, ⁹holding the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience. ¹⁰Let them also first be tested; then let them serve ^v if they are blameless. ¹¹Their wives in the same way must be reverent, not slanderers, temperate, and faithful in all things. ¹²Let servants ^{vi} be husbands of one wife, ruling their children and their own houses well. ¹³For those who have served well ^{vii} gain for themselves a good standing and great boldness in the faith which is in Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁴These things I write to you, hoping to come to you shortly, ¹⁵but if I wait long, that you may know how men ought to behave themselves in God's house, which is the assembly of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth. ¹⁶Without controversy, the mystery of godliness is great: God ^{viii} was revealed in the flesh, justified in the spirit, seen by angels, preached among the nations, believed on in the world, and received up in glory.

⁴But the Spirit says expressly that in later times some will fall away from the faith, paying attention to seducing spirits and doctrines of demons, ²through the hypocrisy of men who speak lies, branded in their own conscience as with a hot iron, ³forbidding marriage and commanding to abstain from foods which God created to be received with thanksgiving by those who believe and know the truth. ⁴For every creature of God is good, and nothing is to be rejected if it is received with thanksgiving. ⁵For it is sanctified through the word of God and prayer. ⁶If you instruct the brothers of these things, you will be a good servant of Messiah Yeshua, nourished in the words of the faith and of the good doctrine which you have followed. ⁷But refuse profane and old wives' fables. Exercise yourself toward godliness. ⁸For bodily exercise has some value, but godliness has value in all things, having the promise of the life which is now and of that which is to come. ⁹This saying is faithful and worthy of all acceptance. ¹⁰For to this end we both labor and suffer reproach, because we have set our trust in the living God, who is the Savior of all men, especially of those who believe. ¹¹Command and teach these things. ¹²Let no man despise your youth; but be an example to those who believe, in word, in your way of life, in love, in spirit, in faith, and in purity. ¹³Until I come, pay attention to reading, to exhortation, and to teaching.

¹⁴Don't neglect the gift that is in you, which was given to you by prophecy with the laying on of the hands of the elders. ¹⁵Be diligent in these things. Give yourself wholly to them, that your progress may be revealed to all. ¹⁶Pay attention to yourself and to your teaching. Continue in these things, for in doing this you will save both yourself and those who hear you.

⁵Don't rebuke an older man, but exhort him as a father; the younger men as brothers; ²the elder women as mothers; the younger as sisters, in all purity. ³Honor widows who are widows indeed. ⁴But if any widow has children or grandchildren, let them learn first to show piety toward their own family and to repay their parents, for this is ^{ix} acceptable in the sight of God. ⁵Now she who is a widow indeed and desolate, has her hope set on God and continues in petitions and prayers night and day. ⁶But she who gives herself to pleasure is dead while she lives. ⁷Also command these things, that they may be without reproach. ⁸But if anyone doesn't provide for his own, and especially his own household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever. ⁹Let no one be enrolled as a widow under sixty years old, having been the wife of one man, ¹⁰being approved by good works, if she has brought up children, if she has been hospitable to strangers, if she has washed the holy ones' feet, if she has relieved the afflicted, and if she has diligently followed every good work. ¹¹But refuse younger widows, for when they have grown wanton against Messiah, they desire to marry, ¹²having condemnation, because they have rejected their first pledge. ¹³Besides, they also learn to be idle, going about from house to house. Not only idle, but also gossips and busybodies, saying things which they ought not. ¹⁴I desire therefore that the younger widows marry, bear children, rule the household, and give no occasion to the adversary for insulting. ¹⁵For already some have turned away after Satan. ¹⁶If any man or woman who believes has widows, let them relieve them, and don't let the assembly be burdened, that it might relieve those who are widows indeed. ¹⁷Let the elders who rule well be counted worthy of double honor, especially those who labor in the word and in teaching. ¹⁸For the Scripture says, "You shall not muzzle the ox when it treads out the grain." And, "The laborer is worthy of his wages." ¹⁹Don't receive an accusation against an elder except at the word of two or three witnesses. ²⁰Those who sin, reprove in the sight of all, that the rest also may be in fear. ²¹I command you in the sight of God, and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, and the chosen angels, that you observe these things without prejudice, doing nothing by partiality. ²²Lay hands hastily on no one. Don't be a participant in other people's sins. Keep yourself pure. ²³Be no longer a drinker of water only, but use a little wine for your stomach's sake and your frequent infirmities. ²⁴Some

^{iv}or, Deacons.

^vor, serve as shamashim

^{vi}or, shamashim

^{vii}or, served well as shamashim

^{viii}NU replaces "God" with "who"

^{ix}TR adds "good and"

men's sins are evident, preceding them to judgment, and some also follow later. ²⁵In the same way also there are good works that are obvious, and those that are otherwise can't be hidden.

²¹which some profess, and thus have wandered from the faith. Grace be with you. Amen.

⁶Let as many as are bondservants under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honor, that the name of God and the doctrine not be blasphemed. ²Those who have believing masters, let them not despise them because they are brothers, but rather let them serve them, because those who partake of the benefit are believing and beloved. Teach and exhort these things. ³If anyone teaches a different doctrine and doesn't consent to sound words, the words of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, and to the doctrine which is according to godliness, ⁴he is conceited, knowing nothing, but obsessed with arguments, disputes, and word battles, from which come envy, strife, insulting, evil suspicions, ⁵constant friction of people of corrupt minds and destitute of the truth, who suppose that godliness is a means of gain. Withdraw yourself from such. ^x ⁶But godliness with contentment is great gain. ⁷For we brought nothing into the world, and we certainly can't carry anything out. ⁸But having food and clothing, we will be content with that. ⁹But those who are determined to be rich fall into a temptation, a snare, and many foolish and harmful lusts, such as drown men in ruin and destruction. ¹⁰For the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil. Some have been led astray from the faith in their greed, and have pierced themselves through with many sorrows. ¹¹But you, man of God, flee these things, and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, perseverance, and gentleness. ¹²Fight the good fight of faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called, and you confessed the good confession in the sight of many witnesses. ¹³I command you before God who gives life to all things, and before Messiah Yeshua who before Pontius Pilate testified the good confession, ¹⁴that you keep the commandment without spot, blameless until the appearing of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ¹⁵which at the right time he will show, who is the blessed and only Ruler, the King of kings and Lord of lords. ¹⁶He alone has immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light, whom no man has seen nor can see, to whom be honor and eternal power. Amen. ¹⁷Charge those who are rich in this present age that they not be arrogant, nor have their hope set on the uncertainty of riches, but on the living God, who richly provides us with everything to enjoy; ¹⁸that they do good, that they be rich in good works, that they be ready to distribute, willing to share; ¹⁹laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold of eternal life. ²⁰Timothy, guard that which is committed to you, turning away from the empty chatter and oppositions of what is falsely called knowledge,

^xNU omits "Withdraw yourself from such."

2 Timothy

¹Paul, an emissary of Yeshua the Messiah ⁱ through the will of God, according to the promise of the life which is in Messiah Yeshua, ²to Timothy, my beloved child: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and Messiah Yeshua our Lord. ³I thank God, whom I serve as my forefathers did, with a pure conscience. How unceasing is my memory of you in my petitions, night and day ⁴longing to see you, remembering your tears, that I may be filled with joy; ⁵having been reminded of the sincere faith that is in you, which lived first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and, I am persuaded, in you also. ⁶For this cause, I remind you that you should stir up the gift of God which is in you through the laying on of my hands. ⁷For God didn't give us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control. ⁸Therefore don't be ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, nor of me his prisoner; but endure hardship for the Good News according to the power of God, ⁹who saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works, but according to his own purpose and grace, which was given to us in Messiah Yeshua before times eternal, ¹⁰but has now been revealed by the appearing of our Savior, Messiah Yeshua, who abolished death, and brought life and immortality to light through the Good News. ¹¹For this I was appointed as a proclaimer, an emissary, and a teacher of the Gentiles. ¹²For this cause I also suffer these things. Yet I am not ashamed, for I know him whom I have believed, and I am persuaded that he is able to guard that which I have committed to him against that day. ¹³Hold the pattern of sound words which you have heard from me, in faith and love which is in Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁴That good thing which was committed to you, guard through the Holy Spirit who dwells in us. ¹⁵This you know, that all who are in Asia turned away from me, of whom are Phygelus and Hermogenes. ¹⁶May the Lord grant mercy to the house of Onesiphorus, for he often refreshed me, and was not ashamed of my chain, ¹⁷but when he was in Rome, he sought me diligently and found me ¹⁸(the Lord grant to him to find the Lord's mercy in that day); and in how many things he served at Ephesus, you know very well.

²You therefore, my child, be strengthened in the grace

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

that is in Messiah Yeshua. ²The things which you have heard from me among many witnesses, commit the same things to faithful men who will be able to teach others also. ³You therefore must endure hardship as a good soldier of Messiah Yeshua. ⁴No soldier on duty entangles himself in the affairs of life, that he may please him who enrolled him as a soldier. ⁵Also, if anyone competes in athletics, he isn't crowned unless he has competed by the rules. ⁶The farmer who labors must be the first to get a share of the crops. ⁷Consider what I say, and may the Lord give you understanding in all things. ⁸Remember Yeshua the Messiah, risen from the dead, of the offspring ⁱⁱ of David, according to my Good News, ⁹in which I suffer hardship to the point of chains as a criminal. But God's word isn't chained. ¹⁰Therefore I endure all things for the chosen ones' sake, that they also may obtain the salvation which is in Messiah Yeshua with eternal glory. ¹¹This saying is trustworthy: "For if we died with him, we will also live with him. ¹²If we endure, we will also reign with him. If we deny him, he also will deny us. ¹³If we are faithless, he remains faithful; for he can't deny himself." ¹⁴Remind them of these things, charging them in the sight of the Lord that they don't argue about words to no profit, to the subverting of those who hear. ¹⁵Give diligence to present yourself approved by God, a workman who doesn't need to be ashamed, properly handling the Word of Truth. ¹⁶But shun empty chatter, for it will go further in ungodliness, ¹⁷and those words will consume like gangrene, of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus: ¹⁸men who have erred concerning the truth, saying that the resurrection is already past, and overthrowing the faith of some. ¹⁹However, God's firm foundation stands, having this seal: "The Lord knows those who are his," and, "Let every one who names the name of the Lord ⁱⁱⁱ depart from unrighteousness." ²⁰Now in a large house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of clay. Some are for honor and some for dishonor. ²¹If anyone therefore purges himself from these, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified, and suitable for the master's use, prepared for every good work. ²²Flee from youthful lusts; but pursue righteousness, faith, love, and

ⁱⁱor, seed

ⁱⁱⁱTR reads "Messiah" instead of "the Lord"

peace with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart. ²³But refuse foolish and ignorant questionings, knowing that they generate strife. ²⁴The Lord's servant must not quarrel, but be gentle toward all, able to teach, patient, ²⁵in gentleness correcting those who oppose him. Perhaps God may give them repentance leading to a full knowledge of the truth, ²⁶and they may recover themselves out of the devil's snare, having been taken captive by him to do his will.

3But know this: that in the last days, grievous times will come. ²For men will be lovers of self, lovers of money, boastful, arrogant, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy, ³without natural affection, unforgiving, slanderers, without self-control, fierce, not lovers of good, ⁴traitors, headstrong, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, ⁵holding a form of godliness but having denied its power. Turn away from these, also. ⁶For some of these are people who creep into houses and take captive gullible women loaded down with sins, led away by various lusts, ⁷always learning and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth. ⁸Even as Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses, so these also oppose the truth, men corrupted in mind, who concerning the faith are rejected. ⁹But they will proceed no further. For their folly will be evident to all men, as theirs also came to be. ¹⁰But you followed my teaching, conduct, purpose, faith, patience, love, steadfastness, ¹¹persecutions, and sufferings—those things that happened to me at Antioch, Iconium, and Lystra. I endured those persecutions. The Lord delivered me out of them all. ¹²Yes, and all who desire to live godly in Messiah Yeshua will suffer persecution. ¹³But evil men and impostors will grow worse and worse, deceiving and being deceived. ¹⁴But you remain in the things which you have learned and have been assured of, knowing from whom you have learned them. ¹⁵From infancy, you have known the holy Scriptures which are able to make you wise for salvation through faith which is in Messiah Yeshua. ¹⁶Every Scripture is God-breathed and ^{iv} profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for instruction in righteousness, ¹⁷that each person who belongs to God may be complete, thoroughly equipped for every good work.

4I command you therefore before God and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, who will judge the living and the dead at his appearing and his Kingdom: ²proclaim the word; be urgent in season and out of season; reprove, rebuke, and exhort with all patience and teaching. ³For the time will come when they will not listen to the sound doctrine, but having itching ears, will heap up for themselves teachers after their own lusts, ⁴and will turn away their ears from the truth, and turn away to fables. ⁵But you be sober in all things, suffer hardship, do the work of an evangelist,

and fulfill your ministry. ⁶For I am already being offered, and the time of my departure has come. ⁷I have fought the good fight. I have finished the course. I have kept the faith. ⁸From now on, the crown of righteousness is stored up for me, which the Lord, the righteous judge, will give to me on that day; and not to me only, but also to all those who have loved his appearing. ⁹Be diligent to come to me soon, ¹⁰for Demas left me, having loved this present world, and went to Thessalonica; Crescens to Galatia; and Titus to Dalmatia. ¹¹Only Luke is with me. Take Mark and bring him with you, for he is useful to me for service. ¹²But I sent Tychicus to Ephesus. ¹³Bring the cloak that I left at Troas with Carpus when you come—and the books, especially the parchments. ¹⁴Alexander the coppersmith did much evil to me. The Lord will repay him according to his deeds. ¹⁵Beware of him, for he greatly opposed our words. ¹⁶At my first defense, no one came to help me, but all left me. May it not be held against them. ¹⁷But the Lord stood by me and strengthened me, that through me the message might be fully proclaimed, and that all the Gentiles might hear. So I was delivered out of the mouth of the lion. ¹⁸And the Lord will deliver me from every evil work and will preserve me for his heavenly Kingdom. To him be the glory forever and ever. Amen. ¹⁹Greet Prisca and Aquila, and the house of Onesiphorus. ²⁰Erastus remained at Corinth, but I left Trophimus at Miletus sick. ²¹Be diligent to come before winter. Eubulus salutes you, as do Pudens, Linus, Claudia, and all the brothers. ²²The Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with your spirit. Grace be with you. Amen.

^{iv}or, Every writing inspired by God is

Titus

¹Paul, a servant of God and an emissary of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ according to the faith of God's chosen ones and the knowledge of the truth which is according to godliness, ²in hope of eternal life, which God, who can't lie, promised before time began; ³but in his own time revealed his word in the message with which I was entrusted according to the commandment of God our Savior, ⁴to Titus, my true child according to a common faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah our Savior. ⁵I left you in Crete for this reason, that you would set in order the things that were lacking and appoint elders in every city, as I directed you— ⁶if anyone is blameless, the husband of one wife, having children who believe, who are not accused of loose or unruly behavior. ⁷For the overseer must be blameless, as God's steward, not self-pleasing, not easily angered, not given to wine, not violent, not greedy for dishonest gain; ⁸but given to hospitality, a lover of good, sober minded, fair, holy, self-controlled, ⁹holding to the faithful word which is according to the teaching, that he may be able to exhort in the sound doctrine, and to convict those who contradict him. ¹⁰For there are also many unruly men, vain talkers and deceivers, especially those of the circumcision, ¹¹whose mouths must be stopped: men who overthrow whole houses, teaching things which they ought not, for dishonest gain's sake. ¹²One of them, a prophet of their own, said, "Cretans are always liars, evil beasts, and idle gluttons." ¹³This testimony is true. For this cause, reprove them sharply, that they may be sound in the faith, ¹⁴not paying attention to Jewish fables and commandments of men who turn away from the truth. ¹⁵To the pure, all things are pure, but to those who are defiled and unbelieving, nothing is pure; but both their mind and their conscience are defiled. ¹⁶They profess that they know God, but by their deeds they deny him, being abominable, disobedient, and unfit for any good work.

²But say the things which fit sound doctrine, ²that older men should be temperate, sensible, sober minded, sound in faith, in love, and in perseverance, ³and that older women likewise be reverent in behavior, not slanderers nor en-

slaved to much wine, teachers of that which is good, ⁴that they may train the young wives to love their husbands, to love their children, ⁵to be sober minded, chaste, workers at home, kind, being in subjection to their own husbands, that God's word may not be blasphemed. ⁶Likewise, exhort the younger men to be sober minded. ⁷In all things show yourself an example of good works. In your teaching, show integrity, seriousness, incorruptibility, ⁸and soundness of speech that can't be condemned, that he who opposes you may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say about us. ⁹Exhort servants to be in subjection to their own masters and to be well-pleasing in all things, not contradicting, ¹⁰not stealing, but showing all good fidelity, that they may adorn the doctrine of God, our Savior, in all things. ¹¹For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to all men, ¹²instructing us to the intent that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we would live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present age; ¹³looking for the blessed hope and appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior, Yeshua the Messiah, ¹⁴who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity and purify for himself a people for his own possession, zealous for good works. ¹⁵Say these things and exhort and reprove with all authority. Let no one despise you.

³Remind them to be in subjection to rulers and to authorities, to be obedient, to be ready for every good work, ²to speak evil of no one, not to be contentious, to be gentle, showing all humility toward all men. ³For we were also once foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving various lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another. ⁴But when the kindness of God our Savior and his love toward mankind appeared, ⁵not by works of righteousness which we did ourselves, but according to his mercy, he saved us through the mikveh of rebirth and renewing by the Holy Spirit, ⁶whom he poured out on us richly through Yeshua the Messiah our Savior; ⁷that being justified by his grace, we might be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life. ⁸This saying is faithful, and concerning these things I desire that you insist confidently, so that those who have believed God may be careful to maintain good works. These things are good and profitable to men; ⁹but shun foolish questionings, genealogies,

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

strife, and disputes about the law; for they are unprofitable and vain. ¹⁰Avoid a factious man after a first and second warning, ¹¹knowing that such a one is perverted and sinful, being self-condemned. ¹²When I send Artemas to you, or Tychicus, be diligent to come to me to Nicopolis, for I have determined to winter there. ¹³Send Zenas the Torah scholar and Apollos on their journey speedily, that nothing may be lacking for them. ¹⁴Let our people also learn to maintain good works to meet necessary needs, that they may not be unfruitful. ¹⁵All who are with me greet you. Greet those who love us in faith. Grace be with you all. Amen.

Philemon

¹Paul, a prisoner of Messiah ⁱ Yeshua, and Timothy our brother, to Philemon, our beloved fellow worker, ²to the beloved Apphia, to Archippus our fellow soldier, and to the assembly in your house: ³Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁴I thank my God always, making mention of you in my prayers, ⁵hearing of your love and of the faith which you have toward the Lord Yeshua and toward all the holy ones, ⁶that the fellowship of your faith may become effective in the knowledge of every good thing which is in us in Messiah Yeshua. ⁷For we have much joy and comfort in your love, because the hearts of the holy ones have been refreshed through you, brother. ⁸Therefore though I have all boldness in Messiah to command you that which is appropriate, ⁹yet for love's sake I rather appeal to you, being such a one as Paul, the aged, but also a prisoner of Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁰I appeal to you for my child Onesimus, whom I have become the father of in my chains, ⁱⁱ ¹¹who once was useless to you, but now is useful to you and to me. ¹²I am sending him back. Therefore receive him, that is, my own heart, ¹³whom I desired to keep with me, that on your behalf he might serve me in my chains for the Good News. ¹⁴But I was willing to do nothing without your consent, that your goodness would not be as of necessity, but of free will. ¹⁵For perhaps he was therefore separated from you for a while that you would have him forever, ¹⁶no longer as a slave, but more than a slave, a beloved brother—especially to me, but how much rather to you, both in the flesh and in the Lord. ¹⁷If then you count me a partner, receive him as you would receive me. ¹⁸But if he has wronged you at all or owes you anything, put that to my account. ¹⁹I, Paul, write this with my own hand: I will repay it (not to mention to you that you owe to me even your own self besides). ²⁰Yes, brother, let me have joy from you in the Lord. Refresh my heart in the Lord. ²¹Having confidence in your obedience, I write to you, knowing that you will do even beyond what I say. ²²Also, prepare a guest room for me, for I hope that through your prayers I will be restored to you. ²³Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in Messiah Yeshua, greets you, ²⁴as do Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, and Luke,

my fellow workers. ²⁵The grace of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with your spirit. Amen.

ⁱ“Messiah” means “Anointed One”.

ⁱⁱOnesimus means “useful”.

Hebrews

¹God, having in the past spoken to the fathers through the prophets at many times and in various ways, ²has at the end of these days spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, through whom also he made the worlds. ³His Son is the radiance of his glory, the very image of his substance, and upholding all things by the word of his power, who, when he had by himself purified us of our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high, ⁴having become as much better than the angels as the more excellent name he has inherited is better than theirs. ⁵For to which of the angels did he say at any time, “You are my Son. Today I have become your father?” and again, “I will be to him a Father, and he will be to me a Son?” ⁶When he again brings in the firstborn into the world he says, “Let all the angels of God worship him.” ⁷Of the angels he says, “He makes his angels winds, and his servants a flame of fire.” ⁸But of the Son he says, “Your throne, O God, is forever and ever. The scepter of uprightness is the scepter of your Kingdom. ⁹You have loved righteousness and hated iniquity; therefore God, your God, has anointed you with the oil of gladness above your fellows.” ¹⁰And, “You, Lord, in the beginning, laid the foundation of the earth. The heavens are the works of your hands. ¹¹They will perish, but you continue. They all will grow old like a garment does. ¹²You will roll them up like a mantle, and they will be changed; but you are the same. Your years won’t fail.” ¹³But which of the angels has he told at any time, “Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies the footstool of your feet?” ¹⁴Aren’t they all serving spirits, sent out to do service for the sake of those who will inherit salvation?

²Therefore we ought to pay greater attention to the things that were heard, lest perhaps we drift away. ²For if the word spoken through angels proved steadfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just penalty, ³how will we escape if we neglect so great a salvation—which at the first having been spoken through the Lord, was confirmed to us by those who heard, ⁴God also testifying with them, both by signs and wonders, by various works of power, and by gifts of the Holy Spirit, according to his own will? ⁵For he didn’t subject the world to come, of which we speak, to angels. ⁶But one has somewhere testified, saying, “What is man, that you think of him?

Or the son of man, that you care for him? ⁷You made him a little lower than the angels. You crowned him with glory and honor. ⁱ ⁸You have put all things in subjection under his feet.” For in that he subjected all things to him, he left nothing that is not subject to him. But now we don’t yet see all things subjected to him. ⁹But we see him who has been made a little lower than the angels, Yeshua, because of the suffering of death crowned with glory and honor, that by the grace of God he should taste of death for everyone. ¹⁰For it became him, for whom are all things and through whom are all things, in bringing many children to glory, to make the author of their salvation perfect through sufferings. ¹¹For both he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all from one, for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brothers, ⁱⁱ ¹²saying, “I will declare your name to my brothers. Among the congregation I will sing your praise.” ¹³Again, “I will put my trust in him.” Again, “Behold, here I am with the children whom God has given me.” ¹⁴Since then the children have shared in flesh and blood, he also himself in the same way partook of the same, that through death he might bring to nothing him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, ¹⁵and might deliver all of them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage. ¹⁶For most certainly, he doesn’t give help to angels, but he gives help to the offspring ⁱⁱⁱ of Abraham. ¹⁷Therefore he was obligated in all things to be made like his brothers, that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God, to make atonement for the sins of the people. ¹⁸For in that he himself has suffered being tempted, he is able to help those who are tempted.

³Therefore, holy brothers, partakers of a heavenly calling, consider the Emissary and High Priest of our confession: Yeshua, ²who was faithful to him who appointed him, as also Moses was in all his house. ³For he has been counted worthy of more glory than Moses, because he who built the house has more honor than the house. ⁴For every house is built by someone; but he who built all things

ⁱTR adds “and set him over the works of your hands”

ⁱⁱThe word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.”

ⁱⁱⁱor, seed

is God. ⁵Moses indeed was faithful in all his house as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were afterward to be spoken, ⁶but Messiah ^{iv} is faithful as a Son over his house. We are his house, if we hold fast our confidence and the glorying of our hope firm to the end. ⁷Therefore, even as the Holy Spirit says, “Today if you will hear his voice, ⁸don’t harden your hearts as in the rebellion, in the day of the trial in the wilderness, ⁹where your fathers tested me and tried me, and saw my deeds for forty years. ¹⁰Therefore I was displeased with that generation, and said, ‘They always err in their heart, but they didn’t know my ways.’ ¹¹As I swore in my wrath, ‘They will not enter into my rest.’” ¹²Beware, brothers, lest perhaps there might be in any one of you an evil heart of unbelief, in falling away from the living God; ¹³but exhort one another day by day, so long as it is called “today”, lest any one of you be hardened by the deceitfulness of sin. ¹⁴For we have become partakers of Messiah, if we hold the beginning of our confidence firm to the end, ¹⁵while it is said, “Today if you will hear his voice, don’t harden your hearts, as in the rebellion.” ¹⁶For who, when they heard, rebelled? Wasn’t it all those who came out of Egypt led by Moses? ¹⁷With whom was he displeased forty years? Wasn’t it with those who sinned, whose bodies fell in the wilderness? ¹⁸To whom did he swear that they wouldn’t enter into his rest, but to those who were disobedient? ¹⁹We see that they weren’t able to enter in because of unbelief.

⁴Let’s fear therefore, lest perhaps anyone of you should seem to have come short of a promise of entering into his rest. ²For indeed we have had good news preached to us, even as they also did, but the word they heard didn’t profit them, because it wasn’t mixed with faith by those who heard. ³For we who have believed do enter into that rest, even as he has said, “As I swore in my wrath, they will not enter into my rest;” although the works were finished from the foundation of the world. ⁴For he has said this somewhere about the seventh day, “God rested on the seventh day from all his works;” ⁵and in this place again, “They will not enter into my rest.” ⁶Seeing therefore it remains that some should enter into it, and they to whom the good news was preached before failed to enter in because of disobedience, ⁷he again defines a certain day, “today”, saying through David so long a time afterward (just as has been said), “Today if you will hear his voice, don’t harden your hearts.” ⁸For if Joshua had given them rest, he would not have spoken afterward of another day. ⁹There remains therefore a Sabbath rest for the people of God. ¹⁰For he who has entered into his rest has himself also rested from his works, as God did from his. ¹¹Let’s therefore give diligence to enter into that rest, lest anyone fall after the same example of disobedience. ¹²For the word of God is living and active, and sharper than any

two-edged sword, piercing even to the dividing of soul and spirit, of both joints and marrow, and is able to discern the thoughts and intentions of the heart. ¹³There is no creature that is hidden from his sight, but all things are naked and laid open before the eyes of him to whom we must give an account. ¹⁴Having then a great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Yeshua, the Son of God, let’s hold tightly to our confession. ¹⁵For we don’t have a high priest who can’t be touched with the feeling of our infirmities, but one who has been in all points tempted like we are, yet without sin. ¹⁶Let’s therefore draw near with boldness to the throne of grace, that we may receive mercy and may find grace for help in time of need.

⁵For every high priest, being taken from among men, is appointed for men in things pertaining to God, that he may offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins. ²The high priest can deal gently with those who are ignorant and going astray, because he himself is also surrounded with weakness. ³Because of this, he must offer sacrifices for sins for the people, as well as for himself. ⁴Nobody takes this honor on himself, but he is called by God, just like Aaron was. ⁵So also Messiah didn’t glorify himself to be made a high priest, but it was he who said to him, “You are my Son. Today I have become your father.” ⁶As he says also in another place, “You are a priest forever, after the order of Melchizedek.” ⁷He, in the days of his flesh, having offered up prayers and petitions with strong crying and tears to him who was able to save him from death, and having been heard for his godly fear, ⁸though he was a Son, yet learned obedience by the things which he suffered. ⁹Having been made perfect, he became to all of those who obey him the author of eternal salvation, ¹⁰named by God a high priest after the order of Melchizedek. ¹¹About him we have many words to say, and hard to interpret, seeing you have become dull of hearing. ¹²For although by this time you should be teachers, you again need to have someone teach you the rudiments of the first principles of the revelations of God. You have come to need milk, and not solid food. ¹³For everyone who lives on milk is not experienced in the word of righteousness, for he is a baby. ¹⁴But solid food is for those who are full grown, who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern good and evil.

⁶Therefore leaving the teaching of the first principles of Messiah, let’s press on to perfection—not laying again a foundation of repentance from dead works, of faith toward God, ²of the teaching of immersions ^v, or, washings of laying on of hands, of resurrection of the dead, and of eternal judgment. ³This will we do, if God permits. ⁴For concerning those who were once enlightened and tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Spirit, ⁵and tasted the good word of God and the powers of the

^{iv}“Messiah” means “Anointed One”.

^vor, washings,

age to come, ⁶and then fell away, it is impossible to renew them again to repentance; seeing they crucify the Son of God for themselves again, and put him to open shame. ⁷For the land which has drunk the rain that comes often on it and produces a crop suitable for them for whose sake it is also tilled, receives blessing from God; ⁸but if it bears thorns and thistles, it is rejected and near being cursed, whose end is to be burned. ⁹But, beloved, we are persuaded of better things for you, and things that accompany salvation, even though we speak like this. ¹⁰For God is not unrighteous, so as to forget your work and the labor of love which you showed toward his name, in that you served the holy ones, and still do serve them. ¹¹We desire that each one of you may show the same diligence to the fullness of hope even to the end, ¹²that you won't be sluggish, but imitators of those who through faith and perseverance inherited the promises. ¹³For when God made a promise to Abraham, since he could swear by no one greater, he swore by himself, ¹⁴saying, "Surely blessing I will bless you, and multiplying I will multiply you." ¹⁵Thus, having patiently endured, he obtained the promise. ¹⁶For men indeed swear by a greater one, and in every dispute of theirs the oath is final for confirmation. ¹⁷In this way God, being determined to show more abundantly to the heirs of the promise the immutability of his counsel, interposed with an oath, ¹⁸that by two immutable things, in which it is impossible for God to lie, we may have a strong encouragement, who have fled for refuge to take hold of the hope set before us. ¹⁹This hope we have as an anchor of the soul, a hope both sure and steadfast and entering into that which is within the veil, ²⁰where as a forerunner Yeshua entered for us, having become a high priest forever after the order of Melchizedek.

⁷For this Melchizedek, king of Salem, priest of God Most High, who met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings and blessed him, ²to whom also Abraham divided a tenth part of all (being first, by interpretation, "king of righteousness", and then also "king of Salem", which means "king of peace", ³without father, without mother, without genealogy, having neither beginning of days nor end of life, but made like the Son of God), remains a priest continually. ⁴Now consider how great this man was, to whom even Abraham the patriarch gave a tenth out of the best plunder. ⁵They indeed of the sons of Levi who receive the priest's office have a commandment to take tithes from the people according to the Torah, that is, of their brothers, though these have come out of the body of Abraham, ⁶but he whose genealogy is not counted from them has accepted tithes from Abraham, and has blessed him who has the promises. ⁷But without any dispute the lesser is blessed by the greater. ⁸Here people who die receive tithes, but there one receives tithes of whom it is testified that he lives. ⁹We can say that through Abraham

even Levi, who receives tithes, has paid tithes, ¹⁰for he was yet in the body of his father when Melchizedek met him. ¹¹Now if perfection was through the Levitical priesthood (for under it the people have received the law), what further need was there for another priest to arise after the order of Melchizedek, and not be called after the order of Aaron? ¹²For the priesthood being changed, there is of necessity a change made also in the law. ¹³For he of whom these things are said belongs to another tribe, from which no one has officiated at the altar. ¹⁴For it is evident that our Lord has sprung out of Judah, about which tribe Moses spoke nothing concerning priesthood. ¹⁵This is yet more abundantly evident, if after the likeness of Melchizedek there arises another priest, ¹⁶who has been made, not after the law of a fleshly commandment, but after the power of an endless life; ¹⁷for it is testified, "You are a priest forever, according to the order of Melchizedek." ¹⁸For there is an annulling of a foregoing commandment because of its weakness and uselessness ¹⁹(for the law made nothing perfect), and a bringing in of a better hope, through which we draw near to God. ²⁰Inasmuch as he was not made priest without the taking of an oath ²¹(for they indeed have been made priests without an oath), but he with an oath by him that says of him, "The Lord swore and will not change his mind, 'You are a priest forever, according to the order of Melchizedek.'" ²²By so much, Yeshua has become the guarantee of a better covenant. ²³Many, indeed, have been made priests, because they are hindered from continuing by death. ²⁴But he, because he lives forever, has his priesthood unchangeable. ²⁵Therefore he is also able to save to the uttermost those who draw near to God through him, seeing that he lives forever to make intercession for them. ²⁶For such a high priest was fitting for us: holy, guiltless, undefiled, separated from sinners, and made higher than the heavens; ²⁷who doesn't need, like those high priests, to offer up sacrifices daily, first for his own sins, and then for the sins of the people. For he did this once for all, when he offered up himself. ²⁸For the Torah appoints men as high priests who have weakness, but the word of the oath, which came after the law, appoints a Son forever who has been perfected.

⁸Now in the things which we are saying, the main point is this: we have such a high priest, who sat down on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens, ²a servant of the sanctuary and of the true tabernacle which the Lord pitched, not man. ³For every high priest is appointed to offer both gifts and sacrifices. Therefore it is necessary that this high priest also have something to offer. ⁴For if he were on earth, he would not be a priest at all, seeing there are priests who offer the gifts according to the Torah, ⁵who serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly things, even as Moses was warned by God when he was about to make the tabernacle, for he said, "See, you shall

make everything according to the pattern that was shown to you on the mountain.” ⁶But now he has obtained a more excellent ministry, by as much as he is also the mediator of a better covenant, which on better promises has been given as Torah. ⁷For if that first covenant had been faultless, then no place would have been sought for a second. ⁸For finding fault with them, he said, “Behold, ^{vi} the days are coming”, says the Lord, “that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah; ⁹not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt; for they didn’t continue in my covenant, and I disregarded them,” says the Lord. ¹⁰“For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days,” says the Lord: “I will put my laws into their mind; I will also write them on their heart. I will be their God, and they will be my people. ¹¹They will not teach every man his fellow citizen ^{vii} and every man his brother, saying, ‘Know the Lord,’ for all will know me, from their least to their greatest. ¹²For I will be merciful to their unrighteousness. I will remember their sins and lawless deeds no more.” ¹³In that he says, “A new covenant”, he has made the first obsolete. But that which is becoming obsolete and grows aged is near to vanishing away.

⁹Now indeed even the first ^{viii} covenant had ordinances of divine service and an earthly sanctuary. ²For a tabernacle was prepared. In the first part were the lamp stand, the table, and the show bread, which is called the Holy Place. ³After the second veil was the tabernacle which is called the Holy of Holies, ⁴having a golden altar of incense and the ark of the covenant overlaid on all sides with gold, in which was a golden pot holding the manna, Aaron’s rod that budded, and the tablets of the covenant; ⁵and above it cherubim of glory overshadowing the mercy seat, of which things we can’t speak now in detail. ⁶Now these things having been thus prepared, the priests go in continually into the first tabernacle, accomplishing the services, ⁷but into the second the high priest alone, once in the year, not without blood, which he offers for himself and for the errors of the people. ⁸The Holy Spirit is indicating this, that the way into the Holy Place wasn’t yet revealed while the first tabernacle was still standing. ⁹This is a symbol of the present age, where gifts and sacrifices are offered that are incapable, concerning the conscience, of making the worshiper perfect, ¹⁰being only (with foods and drinks and various washings) fleshly ordinances, imposed until a time of reformation. ¹¹But Messiah having come as a high priest of the coming good things, through the greater and

more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this creation, ¹²nor yet through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered in once for all into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal redemption. ¹³For if the blood of goats and bulls, and the ashes of a heifer sprinkling those who have been defiled, sanctify to the cleanness of the flesh, ¹⁴how much more will the blood of Messiah, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without defect to God, cleanse your conscience from dead works to serve the living God? ¹⁵For this reason he is the mediator of a new covenant, since a death has occurred for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first covenant, that those who have been called may receive the promise of the eternal inheritance. ¹⁶For where a last will and testament is, there must of necessity be the death of him who made it. ¹⁷For a will is in force where there has been death, for it is never in force while he who made it lives. ¹⁸Therefore even the first covenant has not been dedicated without blood. ¹⁹For when every commandment had been spoken by Moses to all the people according to the Torah, he took the blood of the calves and the goats, with water and scarlet wool and hyssop, and sprinkled both the book itself and all the people, ²⁰saying, “This is the blood of the covenant which God has commanded you.” ²¹He sprinkled the tabernacle and all the vessels of the ministry in the same way with the blood. ²²According to the Torah, nearly everything is cleansed with blood, and apart from shedding of blood there is no remission. ²³It was necessary therefore that the copies of the things in the heavens should be cleansed with these, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these. ²⁴For Messiah hasn’t entered into holy places made with hands, which are representations of the true, but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us; ²⁵nor yet that he should offer himself often, as the high priest enters into the holy place year by year with blood not his own, ²⁶or else he must have suffered often since the foundation of the world. But now once at the end of the ages, he has been revealed to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself. ²⁷Inasmuch as it is appointed for men to die once, and after this, judgment, ²⁸so Messiah also, having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear a second time, not to deal with sin, but to save those who are eagerly waiting for him.

¹⁰For the Torah, having a shadow of the good to come, not the very image of the things, can never with the same sacrifices year by year, which they offer continually, make perfect those who draw near. ²Or else wouldn’t they have ceased to be offered, because the worshipers, having been once cleansed, would have had no more consciousness of sins? ³But in those sacrifices there is a yearly reminder of sins. ⁴For it is impossible that the blood of bulls and goats should take away sins. ⁵Therefore when he comes into the

^{vi}“Behold”, from “*hineh*”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{vii}TR reads “neighbor” instead of “fellow citizen”

^{viii}TR adds “tabernacle”

world, he says, "You didn't desire sacrifice and offering, but you prepared a body for me. ⁶You had no pleasure in whole burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin. ⁷Then I said, 'Behold, I have come (in the scroll of the book it is written of me) to do your will, O God.'" ⁸Previously saying, "Sacrifices and offerings and whole burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin you didn't desire, neither had pleasure in them" (those which are offered according to the Torah), ⁹then he has said, "Behold, I have come to do your will." He takes away the first, that he may establish the second, ¹⁰by which will we have been sanctified through the offering of the body of Yeshua the Messiah once for all. ¹¹Every priest indeed stands day by day serving and offering often the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins, ¹²but he, when he had offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down on the right hand of God, ¹³from that time waiting until his enemies are made the footstool of his feet. ¹⁴For by one offering he has perfected forever those who are being sanctified. ¹⁵The Holy Spirit also testifies to us, for after saying, ¹⁶"This is the covenant that I will make with them after those days," says the Lord, "I will put my laws on their heart, I will also write them on their mind;" then he says, ¹⁷"I will remember their sins and their iniquities no more." ¹⁸Now where remission of these is, there is no more offering for sin. ¹⁹Having therefore, brothers, boldness to enter into the holy place by the blood of Yeshua, ²⁰by the way which he dedicated for us, a new and living way, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh, ²¹and having a great priest over God's house, ²²let's draw near with a true heart in fullness of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience and having our body washed with pure water, ²³let's hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering; for he who promised is faithful. ²⁴Let's consider how to provoke one another to love and good works, ²⁵not forsaking our own assembling together, as the custom of some is, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching. ²⁶For if we sin willfully after we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remains no more a sacrifice for sins, ²⁷but a certain fearful expectation of judgment, and a fierceness of fire which will devour the adversaries. ²⁸A man who disregards the Torah of Moses dies without compassion on the word of two or three witnesses. ²⁹How much worse punishment do you think he will be judged worthy of who has trodden under foot the Son of God, and has counted the blood of the covenant with which he was sanctified an unholy thing, and has insulted the Spirit of grace? ³⁰For we know him who said, "Vengeance belongs to me. I will repay," says the Lord. Again, "The Lord will judge his people." ³¹It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God. ³²But remember the former days, in which, after you were enlightened, you endured a great struggle with sufferings: ³³partly, being exposed to both reproaches and oppressions, and partly, becoming

partakers with those who were treated so. ³⁴For you both had compassion on me in my chains and joyfully accepted the plundering of your possessions, knowing that you have for yourselves a better possession and an enduring one in the heavens. ³⁵Therefore don't throw away your boldness, which has a great reward. ³⁶For you need endurance so that, having done the will of God, you may receive the promise. ³⁷"In a very little while, he who comes will come and will not wait. ³⁸But the righteous one will live by faith. If he shrinks back, my soul has no pleasure in him." ³⁹But we are not of those who shrink back to destruction, but of those who have faith to the saving of the soul.

11Now faith is assurance of things hoped for, proof of things not seen. ²For by this, the elders obtained approval. ³By faith we understand that the universe has been framed by the word of God, so that what is seen has not been made out of things which are visible. ⁴By faith Abel offered to God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, through which he had testimony given to him that he was righteous, God testifying with respect to his gifts; and through it he, being dead, still speaks. ⁵By faith Enoch was taken away, so that he wouldn't see death, and he was not found, because God translated him. For he has had testimony given to him that before his translation he had been well pleasing to God. ⁶Without faith it is impossible to be well pleasing to him, for he who comes to God must believe that he exists, and that he is a rewarder of those who seek him. ⁷By faith Noah, being warned about things not yet seen, moved with godly fear, ^{ix} prepared a ship for the saving of his house, through which he condemned the world and became heir of the righteousness which is according to faith. ⁸By faith Abraham, when he was called, obeyed to go out to the place which he was to receive for an inheritance. He went out, not knowing where he went. ⁹By faith he lived as an alien in the land of promise, as in a land not his own, dwelling in tents with Isaac and Jacob, the heirs with him of the same promise. ¹⁰For he was looking for the city which has foundations, whose builder and maker is God. ¹¹By faith even Sarah herself received power to conceive, and she bore a child when she was past age, since she counted him faithful who had promised. ¹²Therefore as many as the stars of the sky in multitude, and as innumerable as the sand which is by the sea shore, were fathered by one man, and him as good as dead. ¹³These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen ^x them and embraced them from afar, and having confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth. ¹⁴For those who say such things make it clear that they are seeking a country of their own. ¹⁵If indeed they had been thinking of that country from which they went out, they would have had enough time to

^{ix}or, reverence

^xTR adds "and being convinced of"

return. ¹⁶But now they desire a better country, that is, a heavenly one. Therefore God is not ashamed of them, to be called their God, for he has prepared a city for them. ¹⁷By faith, Abraham, being tested, offered up Isaac. Yes, he who had gladly received the promises was offering up his only born ^{xi} son, ¹⁸to whom it was said, “Your offspring will be accounted as from Isaac,” ¹⁹concluding that God is able to raise up even from the dead. Figuratively speaking, he also did receive him back from the dead. ²⁰By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau, even concerning things to come. ²¹By faith Jacob, when he was dying, blessed each of the sons of Joseph, and worshiped, leaning on the top of his staff. ²²By faith Joseph, when his end was near, made mention of the departure of the children of Israel, and gave instructions concerning his bones. ²³By faith Moses, when he was born, was hidden for three months by his parents, because they saw that he was a beautiful child; and they were not afraid of the king’s commandment. ²⁴By faith Moses, when he had grown up, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh’s daughter, ²⁵choosing rather to share ill treatment with God’s people than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a time, ²⁶considering the reproach of the Messiah greater riches than the treasures of Egypt; for he looked to the reward. ²⁷By faith he left Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king; for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible. ²⁸By faith he kept the Passover and the sprinkling of the blood, that the destroyer of the firstborn should not touch them. ²⁹By faith they passed through the Sea of Suf as on dry land. When the Egyptians tried to do so, they were swallowed up. ³⁰By faith the walls of Jericho fell down after they had been encircled for seven days. ³¹By faith Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace. ³²What more shall I say? For the time would fail me if I told of Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, David, Samuel, and the prophets— ³³who through faith subdued kingdoms, worked out righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions, ³⁴quenched the power of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, from weakness were made strong, grew mighty in war, and caused foreign armies to flee. ³⁵Women received their dead by resurrection. Others were tortured, not accepting their deliverance, that they might obtain a better resurrection. ³⁶Others were tried by mocking and scourging, yes, moreover by bonds and imprisonment. ³⁷They were stoned. They were sawn apart. They were tempted. They were slain with the sword. They went around in sheep skins and in goat skins; being destitute, afflicted, ill-treated— ³⁸of whom the world was not worthy—wandering in deserts, mountains, caves, and the holes of the earth. ³⁹These all, having been commended for their faith, didn’t receive the promise, ⁴⁰God having provided some better thing concerning us, so that apart

from us they should not be made perfect.

12Therefore let’s also, seeing we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, lay aside every weight and the sin which so easily entangles us, and let’s run with perseverance the race that is set before us, ²looking to Yeshua, the author and perfecter of faith, who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising its shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God. ³For consider him who has endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, that you don’t grow weary, fainting in your souls. ⁴You have not yet resisted to blood, striving against sin. ⁵You have forgotten the exhortation which reasons with you as with children, “My son, don’t take lightly the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when you are reprov’d by him; ⁶for whom the Lord loves, he disciplines, and chastises every son whom he receives.” ⁷It is for discipline that you endure. God deals with you as with children, for what son is there whom his father doesn’t discipline? ⁸But if you are without discipline, of which all have been made partakers, then you are illegitimate, and not children. ⁹Furthermore, we had the fathers of our flesh to chasten us, and we paid them respect. Shall we not much rather be in subjection to the Father of spirits and live? ¹⁰For they indeed for a few days disciplined us as seemed good to them, but he for our profit, that we may be partakers of his holiness. ¹¹All chastening seems for the present to be not joyous but grievous; yet afterward it yields the peaceful fruit of righteousness to those who have been trained by it. ¹²Therefore lift up the hands that hang down and the feeble knees, ¹³and make straight paths for your feet, so what is lame may not be dislocated, but rather be healed. ¹⁴Follow after peace with all men, and the sanctification without which no man will see the Lord, ¹⁵looking carefully lest there be any man who falls short of the grace of God, lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you and many be defiled by it, ¹⁶lest there be any sexually immoral person or profane person, like Esau, who sold his birthright for one meal. ¹⁷For you know that even when he afterward desired to inherit the blessing, he was rejected, for he found no place for a change of mind though he sought it diligently with tears. ¹⁸For you have not come to a mountain that might be touched and that burned with fire, and to blackness, darkness, storm, ¹⁹the sound of a shofar, and the voice of words; which those who heard it begged that not one more word should be spoken to them, ²⁰for they could not stand that which was commanded, “If even an animal touches the mountain, it shall be stoned”. ^{xii} ²¹So fearful was the appearance that Moses said, “I am terrified and trembling.” ²²But you have come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to innumerable multitudes of angels, ²³to the festal gathering and assembly of the firstborn who

^{xi}The phrase “only born” is from the Greek word “*monogenēs*”, which is sometimes translated “only begotten” or “one and only”.

^{xii}TR adds “or shot with an arrow”

are enrolled in heaven, to God the Judge of all, to the spirits of just men made perfect, ²⁴to Yeshua, the mediator of a new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling that speaks better than that of Abel. ²⁵See that you don't refuse him who speaks. For if they didn't escape when they refused him who warned on the earth, how much more will we not escape who turn away from him who warns from heaven, ²⁶whose voice shook the earth then, but now he has promised, saying, "Yet once more I will shake not only the earth, but also the heavens." ²⁷This phrase, "Yet once more" signifies the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that have been made, that those things which are not shaken may remain. ²⁸Therefore, receiving a Kingdom that can't be shaken, let's have grace, through which we serve God acceptably, with reverence and awe, ²⁹for our God is a consuming fire.

13Let brotherly love continue. ²Don't forget to show hospitality to strangers, for in doing so, some have entertained angels without knowing it. ³Remember those who are in bonds, as bound with them, and those who are ill-treated, since you are also in the body. ⁴Let marriage be held in honor among all, and let the bed be undefiled; but God will judge the sexually immoral and adulterers. ⁵Be free from the love of money, content with such things as you have, for he has said, "I will in no way leave you, neither will I in any way forsake you." ⁶So that with good courage we say, "The Lord is my helper. I will not fear. What can man do to me?" ⁷Remember your leaders, men who spoke to you the word of God, and considering the results of their conduct, imitate their faith. ⁸Yeshua the Messiah is the same yesterday, today, and forever. ⁹Don't be carried away by various and strange teachings, for it is good that the heart be established by grace, not by foods, through which those who were so occupied were not benefited. ¹⁰We have an altar from which those who serve the holy tabernacle have no right to eat. ¹¹For the bodies of those animals, whose blood is brought into the holy place by the high priest as an offering for sin, are burned outside of the camp. ¹²Therefore Yeshua also, that he might sanctify the people through his own blood, suffered outside of the gate. ¹³Let's therefore go out to him outside of the camp, bearing his reproach. ¹⁴For we don't have here an enduring city, but we seek that which is to come. ¹⁵Through him, then, let's offer up a sacrifice of praise to God continually, that is, the fruit of lips which proclaim allegiance to his name. ¹⁶But don't forget to be doing good and sharing, for with such sacrifices God is well pleased. ¹⁷Obeys your leaders and submit to them, for they watch on behalf of your souls, as those who will give account, that they may do this with joy and not with groaning, for that would be unprofitable for you. ¹⁸Pray for us, for we are persuaded that we have a good conscience, desiring to live honorably in all things. ¹⁹I strongly urge you to do

this, that I may be restored to you sooner. ²⁰Now may the God of peace, who brought again from the dead the great shepherd of the sheep with the blood of an eternal covenant, our Lord Yeshua, ²¹make you complete in every good work to do his will, working in you that which is well pleasing in his sight, through Yeshua the Messiah, to whom be the glory forever and ever. Amen. ²²But I exhort you, brothers, endure the word of exhortation, for I have written to you in few words. ²³Know that our brother Timothy has been freed, with whom, if he comes shortly, I will see you. ²⁴Greet all of your leaders and all the holy ones. The Italians greet you. ²⁵Grace be with you all. Amen.

Jacob

¹Jacob, a servant of God and of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ to the twelve tribes which are in the Diaspora: Greetings. ²Count it all joy, my brothers, ⁱⁱ when you fall into various temptations, ³knowing that the testing of your faith produces endurance. ⁴Let endurance have its perfect work, that you may be perfect and complete, lacking in nothing. ⁵But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask of God, who gives to all liberally and without reproach, and it will be given to him. ⁶But let him ask in faith, without any doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, driven by the wind and tossed. ⁷For that man shouldn't think that he will receive anything from the Lord. ⁸He is a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways. ⁹Let the brother in humble circumstances glory in his high position; ¹⁰and the rich, in that he is made humble, because like the flower in the grass, he will pass away. ¹¹For the sun arises with the scorching wind and withers the grass; and the flower in it falls, and the beauty of its appearance perishes. So the rich man will also fade away in his pursuits. ¹²Blessed is a person who endures temptation, for when he has been approved, he will receive the crown of life which the Lord promised to those who love him. ¹³Let no man say when he is tempted, "I am tempted by God," for God can't be tempted by evil, and he himself tempts no one. ¹⁴But each one is tempted when he is drawn away by his own lust and enticed. ¹⁵Then the lust, when it has conceived, bears sin. The sin, when it is full grown, produces death. ¹⁶Don't be deceived, my beloved brothers. ¹⁷Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom can be no variation nor turning shadow. ¹⁸Of his own will he gave birth to us by the word of truth, that we should be a kind of first fruits of his creatures. ¹⁹So, then, my beloved brothers, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, and slow to anger; ²⁰for the anger of man doesn't produce the righteousness of God. ²¹Therefore, putting away all filthiness and overflowing of wickedness, receive with humility the implanted word, which is able to save your souls. ⁱⁱⁱ ²²But be doers of the word, and not only

hearers, deluding your own selves. ²³For if anyone is a hearer of the word and not a doer, he is like a man looking at his natural face in a mirror; ²⁴for he sees himself, and goes away, and immediately forgets what kind of man he was. ²⁵But he who looks into the perfect Torah of freedom and continues, not being a hearer who forgets but a doer of the work, this man will be blessed in what he does. ²⁶If anyone among you thinks himself to be religious while he doesn't bridle his tongue, but deceives his heart, this man's religion is worthless. ²⁷Pure religion and undefiled before our God and Father is this: to visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained by the world.

²My brothers, don't hold the faith of our glorious Lord Yeshua the Messiah with partiality. ²For if a man with a gold ring, in fine clothing, comes into your synagogue, ^{iv} and a poor man in filthy clothing also comes in, ³and you pay special attention to him who wears the fine clothing and say, "Sit here in a good place;" and you tell the poor man, "Stand there," or "Sit by my footstool" ⁴haven't you shown partiality among yourselves, and become judges with evil thoughts? ⁵Listen, my beloved brothers. Didn't God choose those who are poor in this world to be rich in faith and heirs of the Kingdom which he promised to those who love him? ⁶But you have dishonored the poor man. Don't the rich oppress you and personally drag you before the courts? ⁷Don't they blaspheme the honorable name by which you are called? ⁸However, if you fulfill the royal law according to the Scripture, "You shall love your neighbor as yourself," you do well. ⁹But if you show partiality, you commit sin, being convicted by the law as transgressors. ¹⁰For whoever keeps the whole law, and yet stumbles in one point, he has become guilty of all. ¹¹For he who said, "Do not commit adultery," also said, "Do not commit murder." Now if you do not commit adultery but do murder, you have become a transgressor of the law. ¹²So speak and so do as men who are to be judged by the law of freedom. ¹³For judgment is without mercy to him who has shown no mercy. Mercy triumphs over judgment. ¹⁴What good is it, my brothers, if a man says he has faith,

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

ⁱⁱⁱor, preserve your life.

^{iv}or, meeting

but has no works? Can faith save him? ¹⁵And if a brother or sister is naked and in lack of daily food, ¹⁶and one of you tells them, “Go in peace. Be warmed and filled;” yet you didn’t give them the things the body needs, what good is it? ¹⁷Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself. ¹⁸Yes, a man will say, “You have faith, and I have works.” Show me your faith without works, and I will show you my faith by my works. ¹⁹You believe that God is one. You do well. The demons also believe—and shudder. ²⁰But do you want to know, vain man, that faith apart from works is dead? ²¹Wasn’t Abraham our father justified by works, in that he offered up Isaac his son on the altar? ²²You see that faith worked with his works, and by works faith was perfected. ²³So the Scripture was fulfilled which says, “Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him as righteousness,” and he was called the friend of God. ²⁴You see then that by works a man is justified, and not only by faith. ²⁵In the same way, wasn’t Rahab the prostitute also justified by works when she received the messengers and sent them out another way? ²⁶For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, even so faith apart from works is dead.

3Let not many of you be teachers, my brothers, knowing that we will receive heavier judgment. ²For we all stumble in many things. Anyone who doesn’t stumble in word is a perfect person, able to bridle the whole body also. ³Indeed, we put bits into the horses’ mouths so that they may obey us, and we guide their whole body. ⁴Behold, ^v the ships also, though they are so big and are driven by fierce winds, are yet guided by a very small rudder, wherever the pilot desires. ⁵So the tongue is also a little member, and boasts great things. See how a small fire can spread to a large forest! ⁶And the tongue is a fire. The world of iniquity among our members is the tongue, which defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature, and is set on fire by Gehinnom. ^{vi} ⁷For every kind of animal, bird, creeping thing, and sea creature is tamed, and has been tamed by mankind; ⁸but nobody can tame the tongue. It is a restless evil, full of deadly poison. ⁹With it we bless our God and Father, and with it we curse men who are made in the image of God. ¹⁰Out of the same mouth comes blessing and cursing. My brothers, these things ought not to be so. ¹¹Does a spring send out from the same opening fresh and bitter water? ¹²Can a fig tree, my brothers, yield olives, or a vine figs? Thus no spring yields both salt water and fresh water. ¹³Who is wise and understanding among you? Let him show by his good conduct that his deeds are done in gentleness of wisdom. ¹⁴But if you have bitter jealousy and selfish ambition in your heart, don’t boast and don’t lie against the truth. ¹⁵This wisdom is not that which comes down from above,

but is earthly, sensual, and demonic. ¹⁶For where jealousy and selfish ambition are, there is confusion and every evil deed. ¹⁷But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceful, gentle, reasonable, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality, and without hypocrisy. ¹⁸Now the fruit of righteousness is sown in peace by those who make peace.

4Where do wars and fightings among you come from? Don’t they come from your pleasures that war in your members? ²You lust, and don’t have. You murder and covet, and can’t obtain. You fight and make war. You don’t have, because you don’t ask. ³You ask, and don’t receive, because you ask with wrong motives, so that you may spend it on your pleasures. ⁴You adulterers and adulteresses, don’t you know that friendship with the world is hostility toward God? Whoever therefore wants to be a friend of the world makes himself an enemy of God. ⁵Or do you think that the Scripture says in vain, “The Spirit who lives in us yearns jealously”? ⁶But he gives more grace. Therefore it says, “God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble.” ⁷Be subject therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you. ⁸Draw near to God, and he will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, you sinners. Purify your hearts, you double-minded. ⁹Lament, mourn, and weep. Let your laughter be turned to mourning and your joy to gloom. ¹⁰Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and he will exalt you. ¹¹Don’t speak against one another, brothers. He who speaks against a brother and judges his brother, speaks against the law and judges the law. But if you judge the law, you are not a doer of the law but a judge. ¹²Only one is the lawgiver, who is able to save and to destroy. But who are you to judge another? ¹³Come now, you who say, “Today or tomorrow let’s go into this city and spend a year there, trade, and make a profit.” ¹⁴Yet you don’t know what your life will be like tomorrow. For what is your life? For you are a vapor that appears for a little time and then vanishes away. ¹⁵For you ought to say, “If the Lord wills, we will both live, and do this or that.” ¹⁶But now you glory in your boasting. All such boasting is evil. ¹⁷To him therefore who knows to do good and doesn’t do it, to him it is sin.

5Come now, you rich, weep and howl for your miseries that are coming on you. ²Your riches are corrupted and your garments are moth-eaten. ³Your gold and your silver are corroded, and their corrosion will be for a testimony against you and will eat your flesh like fire. You have laid up your treasure in the last days. ⁴Behold, the wages of the laborers who mowed your fields, which you have kept back by fraud, cry out; and the cries of those who reaped have entered into the ears of the Lord of Hosts. ^{vii} ⁵You have lived in luxury on the earth, and taken

^v“Behold”, from “ ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{vi}or, Hell

^{vii}Greek: Sabaoth (for Hebrew: Tze’va’ot)

your pleasure. You have nourished your hearts as in a day of slaughter. ⁶You have condemned and you have murdered the righteous one. He doesn't resist you. ⁷Be patient therefore, brothers, until the coming of the Lord. Behold, the farmer waits for the precious fruit of the earth, being patient over it, until it receives the early and late rain. ⁸You also be patient. Establish your hearts, for the coming of the Lord is at hand. ⁹Don't grumble, brothers, against one another, so that you won't be judged. Behold, the judge stands at the door. ¹⁰Take, brothers, for an example of suffering and of perseverance, the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord. ¹¹Behold, we call them blessed who endured. You have heard of the perseverance of Job and have seen the Lord in the outcome, and how the Lord is full of compassion and mercy. ¹²But above all things, my brothers, don't swear— not by heaven, or by the earth, or by any other oath; but let your "yes" be "yes", and your "no", "no", so that you don't fall into hypocrisy.^{viii} ¹³Is any among you suffering? Let him pray. Is any cheerful? Let him sing praises. ¹⁴Is any among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the assembly, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord; ¹⁵and the prayer of faith will heal him who is sick, and the Lord will raise him up. If he has committed sins, he will be forgiven. ¹⁶Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed. The insistent prayer of a righteous person is powerfully effective. ¹⁷Elijah was a man with a nature like ours, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain, and it didn't rain on the earth for three years and six months. ¹⁸He prayed again, and the sky gave rain, and the earth produced its fruit. ¹⁹Brothers, if any among you wanders from the truth and someone turns him back, ²⁰let him know that he who turns a sinner from the error of his way will save a soul from death and will cover a multitude of sins.

^{viii}TR reads "under judgment" instead of "into hypocrisy"

1 Peter

¹Peter, an emissary of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ to the chosen ones who are living as foreigners in the Diaspora in Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia, ²according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, in sanctification of the Spirit, that you may obey Yeshua the Messiah and be sprinkled with his blood: Grace to you and peace be multiplied. ³Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, who according to his great mercy caused us to be born again to a living hope through the resurrection of Yeshua the Messiah from the dead, ⁴to an incorruptible and undefiled inheritance that doesn't fade away, reserved in Heaven for you, ⁵who by the power of God are guarded through faith for a salvation ready to be revealed in the last time. ⁶In this you greatly rejoice, though now for a little while, if need be, you have been grieved in various trials, ⁷that the proof of your faith, which is more precious than gold that perishes, even though it is tested by fire, may be found to result in praise, glory, and honor at the revelation of Yeshua the Messiah— ⁸whom, not having known, you love. In him, though now you don't see him, yet believing, you rejoice greatly with joy that is unspeakable and full of glory, ⁹receiving the result of your faith, the salvation of your souls. ¹⁰Concerning this salvation, the prophets sought and searched diligently. They prophesied of the grace that would come to you, ¹¹searching for who or what kind of time the Spirit of Messiah which was in them pointed to when he predicted the sufferings of Messiah and the glories that would follow them. ¹²To them it was revealed that they served not themselves, but you, in these things, which now have been announced to you through those who preached the Good News to you by the Holy Spirit sent out from heaven; which things angels desire to look into. ¹³Therefore prepare your minds for action. ⁱⁱ Be sober, and set your hope fully on the grace that will be brought to you at the revelation of Yeshua the Messiah— ¹⁴as children of obedience, not conforming yourselves according to your former lusts as in your ignorance, ¹⁵but just as he who called you is holy, you yourselves also be holy in all of your behavior, ¹⁶because it is written, "You

shall be holy, for I am holy." ¹⁷If you call on him as Father, who without respect of persons judges according to each man's work, pass the time of your living as foreigners here in reverent fear, ¹⁸knowing that you were redeemed, not with corruptible things like silver or gold, from the useless way of life handed down from your fathers, ¹⁹but with precious blood, as of a lamb without blemish or spot, the blood of Messiah, ²⁰who was foreknown indeed before the foundation of the world, but was revealed in this last age for your sake, ²¹who through him are believers in God, who raised him from the dead and gave him glory, so that your faith and hope might be in God. ²²Seeing you have purified your souls in your obedience to the truth through the Spirit in sincere brotherly affection, love one another from the heart fervently, ²³having been born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, through the word of God, which lives and remains forever. ²⁴For, "All flesh is like grass, and all of man's glory like the flower in the grass. The grass withers, and its flower falls; ²⁵but the Lord's word endures forever." This is the word of Good News which was preached to you.

²Putting away therefore all wickedness, all deceit, hypocrisies, envies, and all evil speaking, ²as newborn babies, long for the pure spiritual milk, that with it you may grow, ³if indeed you have tasted that the Lord is gracious. ⁴Come to him, a living stone, rejected indeed by men, but chosen by God, precious. ⁵You also as living stones are built up as a spiritual house, to be a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God through Yeshua the Messiah. ⁶Because it is contained in Scripture, "Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ I lay in Zion a chief cornerstone, chosen and precious. He who believes in him will not be disappointed." ⁷For you who believe therefore is the honor, but for those who are disobedient, "The stone which the builders rejected has become the chief cornerstone," ⁸and, "a stumbling stone and a rock of offense." For they stumble at the word, being disobedient, to which also they were appointed. ⁹But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession, that you may proclaim

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱliterally, "gird up the waist of your mind" or "put on the belt of the waist of your mind"

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " " or " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

the excellence of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light. ¹⁰In the past, you were not a people, but now are God's people, who had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy. ¹¹Beloved, I beg you as foreigners and pilgrims to abstain from fleshly lusts which war against the soul, ¹²having good behavior among the nations, so in that of which they speak against you as evildoers, they may see your good works and glorify God in the day of visitation. ¹³Therefore subject yourselves to every ordinance of man for the Lord's sake: whether to the king, as supreme, ¹⁴or to governors, as sent by him for vengeance on evildoers and for praise to those who do well. ¹⁵For this is the will of God, that by well-doing you should put to silence the ignorance of foolish men. ¹⁶Live as free people, yet not using your freedom for a cloak of wickedness, but as bondservants of God. ¹⁷Honor all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honor the king. ¹⁸Servants, be in subjection to your masters with all respect, not only to the good and gentle, but also to the wicked. ¹⁹For it is commendable if someone endures pain, suffering unjustly, because of conscience toward God. ²⁰For what glory is it if, when you sin, you patiently endure beating? But if when you do well, you patiently endure suffering, this is commendable with God. ²¹For you were called to this, because Messiah also suffered for us, leaving you ^{iv} an example, that you should follow his steps, ²²who didn't sin, "neither was deceit found in his mouth." ²³When he was cursed, he didn't curse back. When he suffered, he didn't threaten, but committed himself to him who judges righteously. ²⁴He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live to righteousness. You were healed by his wounds. ^v ²⁵For you were going astray like sheep; but now you have returned to the Shepherd and Overseer ^{vi} of your souls.

3In the same way, wives, be in subjection to your own husbands, so that, even if any don't obey the Word, they may be won by the behavior of their wives without a word, ²seeing your pure behavior in fear. ³Let your beauty come not from the outward adorning of braiding your hair, and of wearing gold ornaments or of putting on fine clothing, ⁴but from the hidden person of the heart, in the incorruptible adornment of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is very precious in God's sight. ⁵For this is how in the past the holy women who hoped in God also adorned themselves, being in subjection to their own husbands. ⁶So Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him lord, whose children you now are if you do well and are not put in fear by any terror. ⁷You husbands, in the same way, live with your wives according to knowledge, giving honor to the woman

as to the weaker vessel, as also being joint heirs of the grace of life, that your prayers may not be hindered. ⁸Finally, all of you be like-minded, compassionate, loving as brothers, tenderhearted, courteous, ⁹not rendering evil for evil or insult for insult; but instead blessing, knowing that you were called to this, that you may inherit a blessing. ¹⁰For, "He who would love life and see good days, let him keep his tongue from evil and his lips from speaking deceit." ¹¹Let him turn away from evil and do good. Let him seek peace and pursue it. ¹²For the eyes of the Lord are on the righteous, and his ears open to their prayer; but the face of the Lord is against those who do evil." ¹³Now who will harm you if you become imitators of that which is good? ¹⁴But even if you should suffer for righteousness' sake, you are blessed. "Don't fear what they fear, neither be troubled." ¹⁵But sanctify the Lord God in your hearts. Always be ready to give an answer to everyone who asks you a reason concerning the hope that is in you, with humility and fear, ¹⁶having a good conscience. Thus, while you are spoken against as evildoers, they may be disappointed who curse your good way of life in Messiah. ¹⁷For it is better, if it is God's will, that you suffer for doing what is right than for doing evil. ¹⁸Because Messiah also suffered for sins once, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring you to God, being put to death in the flesh, but made alive in the Spirit, ¹⁹in whom he also went and preached to the spirits in prison, ²⁰who before were disobedient when God waited patiently in the days of Noah while the ship was being built. In it, few, that is, eight souls, were saved through water. ²¹This is a symbol of immersion, which now saves you—not the putting away of the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience toward God—through the resurrection of Yeshua the Messiah, ²²who is at the right hand of God, having gone into heaven, angels and authorities and powers being made subject to him.

4Therefore, since Messiah suffered for us in the flesh, arm yourselves also with the same mind; for he who has suffered in the flesh has ceased from sin, ²that you no longer should live the rest of your time in the flesh for the lusts of men, but for the will of God. ³For we have spent enough of our past time doing the desire of the Gentiles, and having walked in lewdness, lusts, drunken binges, orgies, carousings, and abominable idolatries. ⁴They think it is strange that you don't run with them into the same excess of riot, speaking evil of you. ⁵They will give account to him who is ready to judge the living and the dead. ⁶For to this end the Good News was preached even to the dead, that they might be judged indeed as men in the flesh, but live as to God in the spirit. ⁷But the end of all things is near. Therefore be of sound mind, self-controlled, and sober in prayer. ⁸And above all things be earnest in your love among yourselves, for love covers a multitude of sins. ⁹Be hospitable to one another without grumbling. ¹⁰As each has received

^{iv}TR reads "us" instead of "you"

^vor, stripes

^{vi}"Overseer" is from the Greek *episkopos*, which can mean overseer, curator, guardian, or superintendent.

a gift, employ it in serving one another, as good managers of the grace of God in its various forms. ¹¹If anyone speaks, let it be as it were the very words of God. If anyone serves, let it be as of the strength which God supplies, that in all things God may be glorified through Yeshua the Messiah, to whom belong the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen. ¹²Beloved, don't be astonished at the fiery trial which has come upon you to test you, as though a strange thing happened to you. ¹³But because you are partakers of Messiah's sufferings, rejoice, that at the revelation of his glory you also may rejoice with exceeding joy. ¹⁴If you are insulted for the name of Messiah, you are blessed, because the Spirit of glory and of God rests on you. On their part he is blasphemed, but on your part he is glorified. ¹⁵But let none of you suffer as a murderer, or a thief, or an evil doer, or a meddler in other men's matters. ¹⁶But if one of you suffers for being a Messianic, let him not be ashamed; but let him glorify God in this matter. ¹⁷For the time has come for judgment to begin with the household of God. If it begins first with us, what will happen to those who don't obey the Good News of God? ¹⁸"If it is hard for the righteous to be saved, what will happen to the ungodly and the sinner?" ¹⁹Therefore let them also who suffer according to the will of God in doing good entrust their souls to him, as to a faithful Creator.

son. ¹⁴Greet one another with a kiss of love. Peace be to all of you who are in Messiah Yeshua. Amen.

⁵Therefore I exhort the elders among you, as a fellow elder and a witness of the sufferings of Messiah, and who will also share in the glory that will be revealed: ²shepherd the flock of God which is among you, exercising the oversight, not under compulsion, but voluntarily; not for dishonest gain, but willingly; ³not as lording it over those entrusted to you, but making yourselves examples to the flock. ⁴When the chief Shepherd is revealed, you will receive the crown of glory that doesn't fade away. ⁵Likewise, you younger ones, be subject to the elder. Yes, all of you clothe yourselves with humility and subject yourselves to one another; for "God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble." ⁶Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time, ⁷casting all your worries on him, because he cares for you. ⁸Be sober and self-controlled. Be watchful. Your adversary, the devil, walks around like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour. ⁹Withstand him steadfast in your faith, knowing that your brothers who are in the world are undergoing the same sufferings. ¹⁰But may the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory by Messiah Yeshua, after you have suffered a little while, perfect, establish, strengthen, and settle you. ¹¹To him be the glory and the power forever and ever. Amen. ¹²Through Silvanus, our faithful brother, as I consider him, I have written to you briefly, exhorting and testifying that this is the true grace of God in which you stand. ¹³She who is in Babylon, chosen together with you, greets you. So does Mark, my

2 Peter

¹Simon Peter, a servant and emissary of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ to those who have obtained a like precious faith with us in the righteousness of our God and Savior, Yeshua the Messiah: ²Grace to you and peace be multiplied in the knowledge of God and of Yeshua our Lord, ³seeing that his divine power has granted to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of him who called us by his own glory and virtue, ⁴by which he has granted to us his precious and exceedingly great promises; that through these you may become partakers of the divine nature, having escaped from the corruption that is in the world by lust. ⁵Yes, and for this very cause adding on your part all diligence, in your faith supply moral excellence; and in moral excellence, knowledge; ⁶and in knowledge, self-control; and in self-control, perseverance; and in perseverance, godliness; ⁷and in godliness, brotherly affection; and in brotherly affection, love. ⁸For if these things are yours and abound, they make you to not be idle or unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ⁹For he who lacks these things is blind, seeing only what is near, having forgotten the cleansing from his old sins. ¹⁰Therefore, brothers, ⁱⁱ be more diligent to make your calling and election sure. For if you do these things, you will never stumble. ¹¹For thus you will be richly supplied with the entrance into the eternal Kingdom of our Lord and Savior, Yeshua the Messiah. ¹²Therefore I will not be negligent to remind you of these things, though you know them and are established in the present truth. ¹³I think it right, as long as I am in this tent, to stir you up by reminding you, ¹⁴knowing that the putting off of my tent comes swiftly, even as our Lord Yeshua the Messiah made clear to me. ¹⁵Yes, I will make every effort that you may always be able to remember these things even after my departure. ¹⁶For we didn't follow cunningly devised fables when we made known to you the power and coming of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah, but we were eyewitnesses of his majesty. ¹⁷For he received from God the Father honor and glory when the voice came to him from the Majestic Glory, "This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well

pleased." ¹⁸We heard this voice come out of heaven when we were with him on the holy mountain. ¹⁹We have the more sure word of prophecy; and you do well that you heed it as to a lamp shining in a dark place, until the day dawns and the morning star arises in your hearts, ²⁰knowing this first, that no prophecy of Scripture is of private interpretation. ²¹For no prophecy ever came by the will of man, but holy men of God spoke, being moved by the Holy Spirit.

²But false prophets also arose among the people, as false teachers will also be among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, denying even the Master who bought them, bringing on themselves swift destruction. ²Many will follow their immoral ⁱⁱⁱ ways, and as a result, the way of the truth will be maligned. ³In covetousness they will exploit you with deceptive words: whose sentence now from of old doesn't linger, and their destruction will not slumber. ⁴For if God didn't spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus, ^{iv} and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for judgment; ⁵and didn't spare the ancient world, but preserved Noah with seven others, a proclaimer of righteousness, when he brought a flood on the world of the ungodly, ⁶and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who would live in an ungodly way, ⁷and delivered righteous Lot, who was very distressed by the lustful life of the wicked ⁸(for that righteous man dwelling among them was tormented in his righteous soul from day to day with seeing and hearing lawless deeds), ⁹then the Lord knows how to deliver the godly out of temptation and to keep the unrighteous under punishment for the day of judgment, ¹⁰but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries, ¹¹whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don't bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord. ¹²But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed, ¹³receiving

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱThe word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

ⁱⁱⁱTR reads "destructive" instead of "immoral"

^{iv}Tartarus is another name for Hell

the wages of unrighteousness; people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you; ¹⁴having eyes full of adultery, and who can't cease from sin, enticing unsettled souls, having a heart trained in greed, accursed children! ¹⁵Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing; ¹⁶but he was rebuked for his own disobedience. A speechless donkey spoke with a man's voice and stopped the madness of the prophet. ¹⁷These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever. ¹⁸For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error; ¹⁹promising them liberty, while they themselves are bondservants of corruption; for a man is brought into bondage by whoever overcomes him. ²⁰For if, after they have escaped the defilement of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Savior Yeshua the Messiah, they are again entangled in it and overcome, the last state has become worse for them than the first. ²¹For it would be better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than after knowing it, to turn back from the holy commandment delivered to them. ²²But it has happened to them according to the true proverb, "The dog turns to his own vomit again," and "the sow that has washed to wallowing in the mire."

³This is now, beloved, the second letter that I have written to you; and in both of them I stir up your sincere mind by reminding you ²that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the emissaries of the Lord and Savior, ³knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts ⁴and saying, "Where is the promise of his coming? For, from the day that the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation." ⁵For they willfully forget that there were heavens from of old, and an earth formed out of water and amid water by the word of God, ⁶by which means the world that existed then, being overflowed with water, perished. ⁷But the heavens that exist now and the earth, by the same word have been stored up for fire, being reserved against the day of judgment and destruction of ungodly men. ⁸But don't forget this one thing, beloved, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. ⁹The Lord is not slow concerning his promise, as some count slowness; but he is patient with us, not wishing that anyone should perish, but that all should come to repentance. ¹⁰But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night, in which the heavens will pass away with a great noise, and the elements will be dissolved with fervent heat; and the earth and the works that are in it will be burned up. ¹¹Therefore, since all

these things will be destroyed like this, what kind of people ought you to be in holy living and godliness, ¹²looking for and earnestly desiring the coming of the day of God, which will cause the burning heavens to be dissolved, and the elements will melt with fervent heat? ¹³But, according to his promise, we look for new heavens and a new earth, in which righteousness dwells. ¹⁴Therefore, beloved, seeing that you look for these things, be diligent to be found in peace, without defect and blameless in his sight. ¹⁵Regard the patience of our Lord as salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also, according to the wisdom given to him, wrote to you, ¹⁶as also in all of his letters, speaking in them of these things. In those, there are some things that are hard to understand, which the ignorant and unsettled twist, as they also do to the other Scriptures, to their own destruction. ¹⁷You therefore, beloved, knowing these things beforehand, beware, lest being carried away with the error of the wicked, you fall from your own steadfastness. ¹⁸But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Yeshua the Messiah. To him be the glory both now and forever. Amen.

1 Yochanan

¹That which was from the beginning, that which we have heard, that which we have seen with our eyes, that which we saw, and our hands touched, concerning the Word of life ²(and the life was revealed, and we have seen, and testify, and declare to you the life, the eternal life, which was with the Father, and was revealed to us); ³that which we have seen and heard we declare to you, that you also may have fellowship with us. Yes, and our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son, Yeshua the Messiah. ⁱ
⁴And we write these things to you, that our joy may be fulfilled. ⁵This is the message which we have heard from him and announce to you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all. ⁶If we say that we have fellowship with him and walk in the darkness, we lie and don't tell the truth. ⁷But if we walk in the light as he is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Yeshua the Messiah his Son, cleanses us from all sin. ⁸If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us. ⁹If we confess our sins, he is faithful and righteous to forgive us the sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness. ¹⁰If we say that we haven't sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.

²My little children, I write these things to you so that you may not sin. If anyone sins, we have a Counselor ⁱⁱ with the Father, Yeshua the Messiah, the righteous. ²And he is the atoning sacrifice ⁱⁱⁱ for our sins, and not for ours only, but also for the whole world. ³This is how we know that we know him: if we keep his commandments. ⁴One who says, "I know him," and doesn't keep his commandments, is a liar, and the truth isn't in him. ⁵But God's love has most certainly been perfected in whoever keeps his word. This is how we know that we are in him: ⁶he who says he remains in him ought himself also to walk just like he walked. ⁷Brothers, I write no new commandment to you, but an old commandment which you had from the beginning. The old commandment is the word which you

heard from the beginning. ⁸Again, I write a new commandment to you, which is true in him and in you, because the darkness is passing away and the true light already shines. ⁹He who says he is in the light and hates his brother is in the darkness even until now. ¹⁰He who loves his brother remains in the light, and there is no occasion for stumbling in him. ¹¹But he who hates his brother is in the darkness, and walks in the darkness, and doesn't know where he is going, because the darkness has blinded his eyes. ¹²I write to you, little children, because your sins are forgiven you for his name's sake. ¹³I write to you, fathers, because you know him who is from the beginning. I write to you, young men, because you have overcome the evil one. I write to you, little children, because you know the Father. ¹⁴I have written to you, fathers, because you know him who is from the beginning. I have written to you, young men, because you are strong, and the word of God remains in you, and you have overcome the evil one. ¹⁵Don't love the world or the things that are in the world. If anyone loves the world, the Father's love isn't in him. ¹⁶For all that is in the world—the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life—isn't the Father's, but is the world's. ¹⁷The world is passing away with its lusts, but he who does God's will remains forever. ¹⁸Little children, these are the end times, and as you heard that the Anti-messiah is coming, even now many anti-messiahs have arisen. By this we know that it is the final hour. ¹⁹They went out from us, but they didn't belong to us; for if they had belonged to us, they would have continued with us. But they left, that they might be revealed that none of them belong to us. ²⁰You have an anointing from the Holy One, and you all have knowledge. ^{iv} ²¹I have not written to you because you don't know the truth, but because you know it, and because no lie is of the truth. ²²Who is the liar but he who denies that Yeshua is the Messiah? This is the Anti-messiah, he who denies the Father and the Son. ²³Whoever denies the Son doesn't have the Father. He who confesses the Son has the Father also. ²⁴Therefore, as for you, let that remain in you which you heard from the beginning. If that which you heard from the beginning remains in you, you also will remain in the Son, and

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱGreek : Counselor, Helper, Intercessor, Advocate, and Comforter.

ⁱⁱⁱ"atoning sacrifice" is from the Greek " ", an appeasing, propitiating, or the means of appeasement or propitiation—the sacrifice that turns away God's wrath because of our sin.

^{iv}Or, "know what is true", or, "know all things"

in the Father. ²⁵This is the promise which he promised us, the eternal life. ²⁶These things I have written to you concerning those who would lead you astray. ²⁷As for you, the anointing which you received from him remains in you, and you don't need for anyone to teach you. But as his anointing teaches you concerning all things, and is true, and is no lie, and even as it taught you, you will remain in him. ²⁸Now, little children, remain in him, that when he appears, we may have boldness and not be ashamed before him at his coming. ²⁹If you know that he is righteous, you know that everyone who practices righteousness has been born of him.

³See how great a love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God! For this cause the world doesn't know us, because it didn't know him. ²Beloved, now we are children of God. It is not yet revealed what we will be; but we know that when he is revealed, we will be like him, for we will see him just as he is. ³Everyone who has this hope set on him purifies himself, even as he is pure. ⁴Everyone who sins also commits lawlessness. Sin is lawlessness. ⁵You know that he was revealed to take away our sins, and no sin is in him. ⁶Whoever remains in him doesn't sin. Whoever sins hasn't seen him and doesn't know him. ⁷Little children, let no one lead you astray. He who does righteousness is righteous, even as he is righteous. ⁸He who sins is of the devil, for the devil has been sinning from the beginning. To this end the Son of God was revealed: that he might destroy the works of the devil. ⁹Whoever is born of God doesn't commit sin, because his seed remains in him, and he can't sin, because he is born of God. ¹⁰In this the children of God are revealed, and the children of the devil. Whoever doesn't do righteousness is not of God, neither is he who doesn't love his brother. ¹¹For this is the message which you heard from the beginning, that we should love one another— ¹²unlike Cain, who was of the evil one and killed his brother. Why did he kill him? Because his deeds were evil, and his brother's righteous. ¹³Don't be surprised, my brothers, if the world hates you. ¹⁴We know that we have passed out of death into life, because we love the brothers. He who doesn't love his brother remains in death. ¹⁵Whoever hates his brother is a murderer, and you know that no murderer has eternal life remaining in him. ¹⁶By this we know love, because he laid down his life for us. And we ought to lay down our lives for the brothers. ¹⁷But whoever has the world's goods and sees his brother in need, then closes his heart of compassion against him, how does God's love remain in him? ¹⁸My little children, let's not love in word only, or with the tongue only, but in deed and truth. ¹⁹And by this we know that we are of the truth and persuade our hearts before him, ²⁰because if our heart condemns us, God is greater than our heart, and knows all things. ²¹Beloved, if our hearts don't condemn us, we have boldness toward

God; ²²so whatever we ask, we receive from him, because we keep his commandments and do the things that are pleasing in his sight. ²³This is his commandment, that we should believe in the name of his Son, Yeshua the Messiah, and love one another, even as he commanded. ²⁴He who keeps his commandments remains in him, and he in him. By this we know that he remains in us, by the Spirit which he gave us.

⁴Beloved, don't believe every spirit, but test the spirits, whether they are of God, because many false prophets have gone out into the world. ²By this you know the Spirit of God: every spirit who confesses that Yeshua the Messiah has come in the flesh is of God, ³and every spirit who doesn't confess that Yeshua the Messiah has come in the flesh is not of God; and this is the spirit of the Antimessiah, of whom you have heard that it comes. Now it is in the world already. ⁴You are of God, little children, and have overcome them, because greater is he who is in you than he who is in the world. ⁵They are of the world. Therefore they speak of the world, and the world hears them. ⁶We are of God. He who knows God listens to us. He who is not of God doesn't listen to us. By this we know the spirit of truth, and the spirit of error. ⁷Beloved, let's love one another, for love is of God; and everyone who loves has been born of God and knows God. ⁸He who doesn't love doesn't know God, for God is love. ⁹By this God's love was revealed in us, that God has sent his only born ^v Son into the world that we might live through him. ¹⁰In this is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son as the atoning sacrifice ^{vi} for our sins. ¹¹Beloved, if God loved us in this way, we also ought to love one another. ¹²No one has seen God at any time. If we love one another, God remains in us, and his love has been perfected in us. ¹³By this we know that we remain in him and he in us, because he has given us of his Spirit. ¹⁴We have seen and testify that the Father has sent the Son as the Savior of the world. ¹⁵Whoever confesses that Yeshua is the Son of God, God remains in him, and he in God. ¹⁶We know and have believed the love which God has for us. God is love, and he who remains in love remains in God, and God remains in him. ¹⁷In this, love has been made perfect among us, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment, because as he is, even so we are in this world. ¹⁸There is no fear in love; but perfect love casts out fear, because fear has punishment. He who fears is not made perfect in love. ¹⁹We love him, ^{vii} because he first loved us. ²⁰If a man says, "I love God," and hates his brother, he is a liar; for he who doesn't love his brother

^vThe phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μόνος", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

^{vi}"atoning sacrifice" is from the Greek "ἱλαστήριον", an appeasing, propitiating, or the means of appeasement or propitiation—the sacrifice that turns away God's wrath because of our sin.

^{vii}NU omits "him".

whom he has seen, how can he love God whom he has not seen? ²¹This commandment we have from him, that he who loves God should also love his brother.

⁵Whoever believes that Yeshua is the Messiah has been born of God. Whoever loves the Father also loves the child who is born of him. ²By this we know that we love the children of God, when we love God and keep his commandments. ³For this is loving God, that we keep his commandments. His commandments are not grievous. ⁴For whatever is born of God overcomes the world. This is the victory that has overcome the world: your faith. ⁵Who is he who overcomes the world, but he who believes that Yeshua is the Son of God? ⁶This is he who came by water and blood, Yeshua the Messiah; not with the water only, but with the water and the blood. It is the Spirit who testifies, because the Spirit is the truth. ⁷For there are three who testify: ^{viii} ⁸the Spirit, the water, and the blood; and the three agree as one. ⁹If we receive the witness of men, the witness of God is greater; for this is God's testimony which he has testified concerning his Son. ¹⁰He who believes in the Son of God has the testimony in himself. He who doesn't believe God has made him a liar, because he has not believed in the testimony that God has given concerning his Son. ¹¹The testimony is this: that God gave to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son. ¹²He who has the Son has the life. He who doesn't have God's Son doesn't have the life. ¹³These things I have written to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, that you may know that you have eternal life, and that you may continue to believe in the name of the Son of God. ¹⁴This is the boldness which we have toward him, that if we ask anything according to his will, he listens to us. ¹⁵And if we know that he listens to us, whatever we ask, we know that we have the petitions which we have asked of him. ¹⁶If anyone sees his brother sinning a sin not leading to death, he shall ask, and God will give him life for those who sin not leading to death. There is sin leading to death. I don't say that he should make a request concerning this. ¹⁷All unrighteousness is sin, and there is sin not leading to death. ¹⁸We know that whoever is born of God doesn't sin, but he who was born of God keeps himself, and the evil one doesn't touch him. ¹⁹We know that we are of God, and the whole world lies in the power of the evil one. ²⁰We know that the Son of God has come and has given us an understanding, that we know him who is true; and we are in him who is true, in his Son Yeshua the Messiah. This is the true God and eternal life. ²¹Little children, keep yourselves from idols.

^{viii}Only a few recent manuscripts add "in heaven: the Father, the Word, and the Holy Spirit; and these three are one. And there are three that testify on earth:"

2 Yochanan

¹The elder, to the chosen lady and her children, whom I love in truth, and not I only, but also all those who know the truth, ²for the truth's sake, which remains in us, and it will be with us forever: ³Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us, from God the Father and from the Lord Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ the Son of the Father, in truth and love. ⁴I rejoice greatly that I have found some of your children walking in truth, even as we have been commanded by the Father. ⁵Now I beg you, dear lady, not as though I wrote to you a new commandment, but that which we had from the beginning, that we love one another. ⁶This is love, that we should walk according to his commandments. This is the commandment, even as you heard from the beginning, that you should walk in it. ⁷For many deceivers have gone out into the world, those who don't confess that Yeshua the Messiah came in the flesh. This is the deceiver and the Anti-messiah. ⁸Watch yourselves, that we don't lose the things which we have accomplished, but that we receive a full reward. ⁹Whoever transgresses and doesn't remain in the teaching of Messiah doesn't have God. He who remains in the teaching has both the Father and the Son. ¹⁰If anyone comes to you and doesn't bring this teaching, don't receive him into your house, and don't welcome him, ¹¹for he who welcomes him participates in his evil deeds. ¹²Having many things to write to you, I don't want to do so with paper and ink, but I hope to come to you and to speak face to face, that our joy may be made full. ¹³The children of your chosen sister greet you. Amen.

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

3 Yochanan

¹The elder to Gaius the beloved, whom I love in truth.
²Beloved, I pray that you may prosper in all things and be healthy, even as your soul prospers. ³For I rejoiced greatly when brothers came and testified about your truth, even as you walk in truth. ⁴I have no greater joy than this: to hear about my children walking in truth. ⁵Beloved, you do a faithful work in whatever you accomplish for those who are brothers and strangers. ⁶They have testified about your love before the assembly. You will do well to send them forward on their journey in a way worthy of God, ⁷because for the sake of the Name they went out, taking nothing from the Gentiles. ⁸We therefore ought to receive such, that we may be fellow workers for the truth. ⁹I wrote to the assembly, but Diotrephes, who loves to be first among them, doesn't accept what we say. ¹⁰Therefore, if I come, I will call attention to his deeds which he does, unjustly accusing us with wicked words. Not content with this, he doesn't receive the brothers himself, and those who would, he forbids and throws out of the assembly. ¹¹Beloved, don't imitate that which is evil, but that which is good. He who does good is of God. He who does evil hasn't seen God. ¹²Demetrius has the testimony of all, and of the truth itself; yes, we also testify, and you know that our testimony is true. ¹³I had many things to write to you, but I am unwilling to write to you with ink and pen; ¹⁴but I hope to see you soon. Then we will speak face to face. Peace be to you. The friends greet you. Greet the friends by name.

Judah

¹Judah, ⁱ a servant of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱⁱ and brother of Jacob, to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Yeshua the Messiah: ²May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you. ³Beloved, while I was very eager to write to you about our common salvation, I was constrained to write to you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the holy ones. ⁴For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into indecency, and denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Yeshua the Messiah. ⁵Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who didn't believe. ⁶Angels who didn't keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day. ⁷Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having in the same way as these given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire. ⁸Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings. ⁹But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!" ¹⁰But these speak evil of whatever things they don't know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason. ¹¹Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah's rebellion. ¹²These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; ¹³wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever. ¹⁴About these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, say-

ing, "Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones, ¹⁵to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him." ¹⁶These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts—and their mouth speaks proud things—showing respect of persons to gain advantage. ¹⁷But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the emissaries of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁸They said to you, "In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts." ¹⁹These are those who cause divisions and are sensual, not having the Spirit. ²⁰But you, beloved, keep building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit. ²¹Keep yourselves in God's love, looking for the mercy of our Lord Yeshua the Messiah to eternal life. ²²On some have compassion, making a distinction, ²³and some save, snatching them out of the fire with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh. ²⁴Now to him who is able to keep them ^{iv} from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy, ²⁵to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen.

ⁱor, Judah

ⁱⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}TR and NU read "you"

Revelation

¹This is the Revelation of Yeshua the Messiah, ⁱ which God gave him to show to his servants the things which must happen soon, which he sent and made known by his angel ⁱⁱ to his servant, Yochanan, ²who testified to God's word and of the testimony of Yeshua the Messiah, about everything that he saw. ³Blessed is he who reads and those who hear the words of the prophecy, and keep the things that are written in it, for the time is near. ⁴Yochanan, to the seven assemblies that are in Asia: Grace to you and peace from God, who is and who was and who is to come; and from the seven Spirits who are before his throne; ⁵and from Yeshua the Messiah, the faithful witness, the firstborn of the dead, and the ruler of the kings of the earth. To him who loves us, and washed us from our sins by his blood— ⁶and he made us to be a Kingdom, priests to his God and Father—to him be the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen. ⁷Behold, ⁱⁱⁱ he is coming with the clouds, and every eye will see him, including those who pierced him. All the tribes of the earth will mourn over him. Even so, Amen. ⁸"I am the Alef and the Tav, ^{iv} " says the Lord God, ^v " who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty." ⁹I Yochanan, your brother and partner with you in the oppression, Kingdom, and perseverance in Messiah Yeshua, was on the isle that is called Patmos because of God's Word and the testimony of Yeshua the Messiah. ¹⁰I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and I heard behind me a loud voice, like a shofar ¹¹saying, ^{vi} "What you see, write in a book and send to the seven assemblies: ^{vii} to Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and to Laodicea." ¹²I turned to see the voice that spoke with me. Having turned, I saw seven golden lamp stands. ¹³And among the lamp stands was one like a son of man, clothed with a robe reaching down to his feet, and with a golden sash around his chest. ¹⁴His head and his hair were white as white wool, like snow. His

eyes were like a flame of fire. ¹⁵His feet were like burnished brass, as if it had been refined in a furnace. His voice was like the voice of many waters. ¹⁶He had seven stars in his right hand. Out of his mouth proceeded a sharp two-edged sword. His face was like the sun shining at its brightest. ¹⁷When I saw him, I fell at his feet like a dead man. He laid his right hand on me, saying, " Don't be afraid. I am the first and the last, ¹⁸and the Living one. I was dead, and behold, I am alive forever and ever. Amen. I have the keys of Death and of Sheol. ^{viii} ¹⁹Write therefore the things which you have seen, and the things which are, and the things which will happen hereafter. ²⁰The mystery of the seven stars which you saw in my right hand, and the seven golden lamp stands is this: The seven stars are the angels ^{ix} of the seven assemblies. The seven lamp stands are seven assemblies.

²" To the angel of the assembly in Ephesus write: " He who holds the seven stars in his right hand, he who walks among the seven golden lamp stands says these things: ²" I know your works, and your toil and perseverance, and that you can't tolerate evil men, and have tested those who call themselves emissaries, and they are not, and found them false. ³You have perseverance and have endured for my name's sake, and have ^x not grown weary. ⁴But I have this against you, that you left your first love. ⁵Remember therefore from where you have fallen, and repent and do the first works; or else I am coming to you swiftly, and will move your lamp stand out of its place, unless you repent. ⁶But this you have, that you hate the works of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate. ⁷He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. To him who overcomes I will give to eat from the tree of life, which is in the Paradise of my God. ⁸" To the angel of the assembly in Smyrna write: " The first and the last, who was dead, and has come to life says these things: ⁹" I know your works, oppression, and your poverty (but you are rich), and the blasphemy of those who say they are Jews, and they are not, but are a synagogue of Satan. ¹⁰Don't be afraid of the things which you are about to suffer. Behold, the devil

ⁱ"Messiah" means "Anointed One".

ⁱⁱor, messenger (here and wherever angel is mentioned)

ⁱⁱⁱ"Behold", from " ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

^{iv}TR adds "the Beginning and the End"

^vTR omits "God"

^{vi}TR adds "I am the Alef and the Tav, the First and the Last."

^{vii}TR adds "which are in Asia"

^{viii}or, Hell

^{ix}or, messengers (here and wherever angels are mentioned)

^xTR adds "have labored and"

is about to throw some of you into prison, that you may be tested; and you will have oppression for ten days. Be faithful to death, and I will give you the crown of life. ¹¹He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. He who overcomes won't be harmed by the second death. ¹²"To the angel of the assembly in Pergamum write: "He who has the sharp two-edged sword says these things: ¹³"I know your works and where you dwell, where Satan's throne is. You hold firmly to my name, and didn't deny my faith in the days of Antipas my witness, my faithful one, who was killed among you, where Satan dwells. ¹⁴But I have a few things against you, because you have there some who hold the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to throw a stumbling block before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed to idols, and to commit sexual immorality. ¹⁵So also you likewise have some who hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans. ^{xi} ¹⁶Repent therefore, or else I am coming to you quickly and I will make war against them with the sword of my mouth. ¹⁷He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. To him who overcomes, to him I will give of the hidden manna, ^{xii} and I will give him a white stone, and on the stone a new name written which no one knows but he who receives it. ¹⁸"To the angel of the assembly in Thyatira write: "The Son of God, who has his eyes like a flame of fire, and his feet are like burnished brass, says these things: ¹⁹"I know your works, your love, faith, service, patient endurance, and that your last works are more than the first. ²⁰But I have this against you, that you tolerate your ^{xiii} woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess. She teaches and seduces my servants to commit sexual immorality and to eat things sacrificed to idols. ²¹I gave her time to repent, but she refuses to repent of her sexual immorality. ²²Behold, I will throw her and those who commit adultery with her into a bed of great oppression, unless they repent of her works. ²³I will kill her children with Death, and all the assemblies will know that I am he who searches the minds and hearts. I will give to each one of you according to your deeds. ²⁴But to you I say, to the rest who are in Thyatira—as many as don't have this teaching, who don't know what some call 'the deep things of Satan'—to you I say, I am not putting any other burden on you. ²⁵Nevertheless, hold that which you have firmly until I come. ²⁶He who overcomes, and he who keeps my works to the end, to him I will give authority over the nations. ²⁷He will rule them with a rod of iron, shattering them like clay pots, as I also have received of my Father; ²⁸and I will give him the morning star. ²⁹He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies.

³"And to the angel of the assembly in Sardis write: "He who has the seven Spirits of God and the seven stars says these things: "I know your works, that you have a reputation of being alive, but you are dead. ²Wake up and strengthen the things that remain, which you were about to throw away, ^{xiv} for I have found no works of yours perfected before my God. ³Remember therefore how you have received and heard. Keep it and repent. If therefore you won't watch, I will come as a thief, and you won't know what hour I will come upon you. ⁴Nevertheless you have a few names in Sardis that didn't defile their garments. They will walk with me in white, for they are worthy. ⁵He who overcomes will be arrayed in white garments, and I will in no way blot his name out of the book of life, and I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels. ⁶He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. ⁷"To the angel of the assembly in Philadelphia write: "He who is holy, he who is true, he who has the key of David, he who opens and no one can shut, and who shuts and no one opens, says these things: ⁸"I know your works (behold, I have set before you an open door, which no one can shut), that you have a little power, and kept my word, and didn't deny my name. ⁹Behold, I make some of the synagogue of Satan, of those who say they are Jews, and they are not, but lie—behold, I will make them to come and worship before your feet, and to know that I have loved you. ¹⁰Because you kept my command to endure, I also will keep you from the hour of testing which is to come on the whole world, to test those who dwell on the earth. ¹¹I am coming quickly! Hold firmly that which you have, so that no one takes your crown. ¹²He who overcomes, I will make him a pillar in the temple of my God, and he will go out from there no more. I will write on him the name of my God and the name of the city of my God, the new Jerusalem, which comes down out of heaven from my God, and my own new name. ¹³He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. ¹⁴"To the angel of the assembly in Laodicea write: "The Amen, the Faithful and True Witness, the Beginning ^{xv} of God's creation, says these things: ¹⁵"I know your works, that you are neither cold nor hot. I wish you were cold or hot. ¹⁶So, because you are lukewarm, and neither hot nor cold, I will vomit you out of my mouth. ¹⁷Because you say, 'I am rich, and have gotten riches, and have need of nothing,' and don't know that you are the wretched one, miserable, poor, blind, and naked; ¹⁸I counsel you to buy from me gold refined by fire, that you may become rich; and white garments, that you may clothe yourself, and that the shame of your nakedness may not be revealed; and eye salve to anoint your eyes, that you may see. ¹⁹As many as I love, I reprove and chasten. Be zealous therefore, and

^{xi}TR reads "which I hate" instead of "likewise"

^{xii}Manna is supernatural food, named after the Hebrew for "What is it?". See

^{xiii}TR, NU read "that" instead of "your"

^{xiv}NU & TR read "which were about to die" instead of "which you were about to throw away".

^{xv}or, Source, or Head

repent. ²⁰Behold, I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, then I will come in to him and will dine with him, and he with me. ²¹He who overcomes, I will give to him to sit down with me on my throne, as I also overcame and sat down with my Father on his throne. ²²He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies.”

⁴After these things I looked and saw a door opened in heaven; and the first voice that I heard, like a shofar speaking with me, was one saying, “Come up here, and I will show you the things which must happen after this.” ²Immediately I was in the Spirit. Behold, there was a throne set in heaven, and one sitting on the throne ³that looked like a jasper stone and a sardius. There was a rainbow around the throne, like an emerald to look at. ⁴Around the throne were twenty-four thrones. On the thrones were twenty-four elders sitting, dressed in white garments, with crowns of gold on their heads. ⁵Out of the throne proceed lightnings, sounds, and thunders. There were seven lamps of fire burning before his throne, which are the seven Spirits of God. ⁶Before the throne was something like a sea of glass, similar to crystal. In the middle of the throne, and around the throne were four living creatures full of eyes before and behind. ⁷The first creature was like a lion, the second creature like a calf, the third creature had a face like a man, and the fourth was like a flying eagle. ⁸The four living creatures, each one of them having six wings, are full of eyes around and within. They have no rest day and night, saying, “Holy, holy, holy ^{xvi} is the Lord God, the Almighty, who was and who is and who is to come!” ⁹When the living creatures give glory, honor, and thanks to him who sits on the throne, to him who lives forever and ever, ¹⁰the twenty-four elders fall down before him who sits on the throne and worship him who lives forever and ever, and throw their crowns before the throne, saying, ¹¹“Worthy are you, our Lord and God, the Holy One, ^{xvii} to receive the glory, the honor, and the power, for you created all things, and because of your desire they existed and were created!”

⁵I saw, in the right hand of him who sat on the throne, a book written inside and outside, sealed shut with seven seals. ²I saw a mighty angel proclaiming with a loud voice, “Who is worthy to open the book, and to break its seals?” ³No one in heaven above, or on the earth, or under the earth, was able to open the book or to look in it. ⁴Then I wept much, because no one was found worthy to open the book or to look in it. ⁵One of the elders said to me, “Don’t weep. Behold, the Lion who is of the tribe of Judah, the Root of David, has overcome: he who opens the book and its seven seals.” ⁶I saw in the middle of the throne and of

the four living creatures, and in the middle of the elders, a Lamb standing, as though it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God, sent out into all the earth. ⁷Then he came, and he took it out of the right hand of him who sat on the throne. ⁸Now when he had taken the book, the four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell down before the Lamb, each one having a harp, and golden bowls full of incense, which are the prayers of the holy ones. ⁹They sang a new song, saying, “You are worthy to take the book and to open its seals, for you were killed, and bought us for God with your blood out of every tribe, language, people, and nation, ¹⁰and made us kings and priests to our God; and we will reign on the earth.” ¹¹I looked, and I heard something like a voice of many angels around the throne, the living creatures, and the elders. The number of them was ten thousands of ten thousands, and thousands of thousands, ¹²saying with a loud voice, “Worthy is the Lamb who has been killed to receive the power, wealth, wisdom, strength, honor, glory, and blessing!” ¹³I heard every created thing which is in heaven, on the earth, under the earth, on the sea, and everything in them, saying, “To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be the blessing, the honor, the glory, and the dominion, forever and ever! Amen!” ^{xviii} ¹⁴The four living creatures said, “Amen!” Then the ^{xix} elders fell down and worshiped. ^{xx}

⁶I saw that the Lamb opened one of the seven seals, and I heard one of the four living creatures saying, as with a voice of thunder, “Come and see!” ²Then a white horse appeared, and he who sat on it had a bow. A crown was given to him, and he came out conquering, and to conquer. ³When he opened the second seal, I heard the second living creature saying, “Come!” ⁴Another came out, a red horse. To him who sat on it was given power to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another. There was given to him a great sword. ⁵When he opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature saying, “Come and see!” And behold, a black horse, and he who sat on it had a balance in his hand. ⁶I heard a voice in the middle of the four living creatures saying, “A choenix ^{xxi} of wheat for a denarius, and three choenix of barley for a denarius! Don’t damage the oil and the wine!” ⁷When he opened the fourth seal, I heard the fourth living creature saying, “Come and see!” ⁸And behold, a pale horse, and the name of he who sat on it was Death. Sheol ^{xxii} followed with him. Authority over one fourth of the earth, to kill with the sword, with famine, with death, and by the wild animals of the earth was given to him. ⁹When he opened the fifth

^{xviii}TR omits “Amen!”

^{xix}TR adds “twenty-four”

^{xx}TR adds “the one living forever and ever”

^{xxi}A choenix is a dry volume measure that is a little more than a liter (a little more than a quart).

^{xxii}or, Hell

^{xvi}Hodges/Farstad MT reads “holy” 9 times instead of 3.

^{xvii}TR omits “and God, the Holy One,”

seal, I saw underneath the altar the souls of those who had been killed for the Word of God, and for the testimony of the Lamb which they had. ¹⁰They cried with a loud voice, saying, "How long, Master, the holy and true, until you judge and avenge our blood on those who dwell on the earth?" ¹¹A long white robe was given to each of them. They were told that they should rest yet for a while, until their fellow servants and their brothers, ^{xxiii} who would also be killed even as they were, should complete their course. ¹²I saw when he opened the sixth seal, and there was a great earthquake. The sun became black as sackcloth made of hair, and the whole moon became as blood. ¹³The stars of the sky fell to the earth, like a fig tree dropping its unripe figs when it is shaken by a great wind. ¹⁴The sky was removed like a scroll when it is rolled up. Every mountain and island was moved out of its place. ¹⁵The kings of the earth, the princes, the commanding officers, the rich, the strong, and every slave and free person, hid themselves in the caves and in the rocks of the mountains. ¹⁶They told the mountains and the rocks, "Fall on us, and hide us from the face of him who sits on the throne, and from the wrath of the Lamb, ¹⁷for the great day of his wrath has come, and who is able to stand?"

⁷After this, I saw four angels standing at the four corners of the earth, holding the four winds of the earth, so that no wind would blow on the earth, or on the sea, or on any tree. ²I saw another angel ascend from the sunrise, having the seal of the living God. He cried with a loud voice to the four angels to whom it was given to harm the earth and the sea, ³saying, "Don't harm the earth, the sea, or the trees, until we have sealed the bondservants of our God on their foreheads!" ⁴I heard the number of those who were sealed, one hundred forty-four thousand, sealed out of every tribe of the children of Israel: ⁵of the tribe of Judah twelve thousand were sealed, of the tribe of Reuben twelve thousand, of the tribe of Gad twelve thousand, ⁶of the tribe of Asher twelve thousand, of the tribe of Naph-tali twelve thousand, of the tribe of Manasseh twelve thousand, ⁷of the tribe of Simeon twelve thousand, of the tribe of Levi twelve thousand, of the tribe of Issachar twelve thousand, ⁸of the tribe of Zebulun twelve thousand, of the tribe of Joseph twelve thousand, and of the tribe of Benjamin twelve thousand were sealed. ⁹After these things I looked, and behold, a great multitude which no man could count, out of every nation and of all tribes, peoples, and languages, standing before the throne and before the Lamb, dressed in white robes, with palm branches in their hands. ¹⁰They cried with a loud voice, saying, "Salvation be to our God, who sits on the throne, and to the Lamb!" ¹¹All the angels were standing around the throne, the elders, and the four living creatures; and they fell on their faces

before his throne, and worshiped God, ¹²saying, "Amen! Blessing, glory, wisdom, thanksgiving, honor, power, and might, be to our God forever and ever! Amen." ¹³One of the elders answered, saying to me, "These who are arrayed in the white robes, who are they, and where did they come from?" ¹⁴I told him, "My lord, you know." He said to me, "These are those who came out of the great suffering. ^{xxiv} They washed their robes and made them white in the Lamb's blood. ¹⁵Therefore they are before the throne of God, and they serve him day and night in his temple. He who sits on the throne will spread his tabernacle over them. ¹⁶They will never be hungry or thirsty any more. The sun won't beat on them, nor any heat; ¹⁷for the Lamb who is in the middle of the throne shepherds them and leads them to springs of life-giving waters. And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes."

⁸When he opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven for about half an hour. ²I saw the seven angels who stand before God, and seven shofars ^{xxv} or, trumpets were given to them. ³Another angel came and stood over the altar, having a golden censer. Much incense was given to him, that he should add it to the prayers of all the holy ones on the golden altar which was before the throne. ⁴The smoke of the incense, with the prayers of the holy ones, went up before God out of the angel's hand. ⁵The angel took the censer, and he filled it with the fire of the altar, then threw it on the earth. Thunders, sounds, lightnings, and an earthquake followed. ⁶The seven angels who had the seven shofars ^{xxvi} or, trumpets prepared themselves to sound. ⁷The first sounded, and there followed hail and fire, mixed with blood, and they were thrown to the earth. One third of the earth was burned up, ^{xxvii} and one third of the trees were burned up, and all green grass was burned up. ⁸The second angel sounded, and something like a great burning mountain was thrown into the sea. One third of the sea became blood, ⁹and one third of the living creatures which were in the sea died. One third of the ships were destroyed. ¹⁰The third angel sounded, and a great star fell from the sky, burning like a torch, and it fell on one third of the rivers, and on the springs of water. ¹¹The name of the star is "Wormwood." One third of the waters became wormwood. Many people died from the waters, because they were made bitter. ¹²The fourth angel sounded, and one third of the sun was struck, and one third of the moon, and one third of the stars, so that one third of them would be darkened; and the day wouldn't shine for one third of it, and the night in the same way. ¹³I saw, and I heard an eagle, ^{xxviii} flying in

^{xxiv} or, oppression

^{xxv} or, trumpets

^{xxvi} or, trumpets

^{xxvii} TR omits "One third of the earth was burned up"

^{xxviii} TR reads "angel" instead of "eagle"

^{xxiii} The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

mid heaven, saying with a loud voice, “Woe! Woe! Woe to those who dwell on the earth, because of the other blasts of the shofars ^{xxix} or, trumpetsof the three angels, who are yet to sound!”

⁹The fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star from the sky which had fallen to the earth. The key to the pit of the abyss was given to him. ²He opened the pit of the abyss, and smoke went up out of the pit, like the smoke from a ^{xxx} burning furnace. The sun and the air were darkened because of the smoke from the pit. ³Then out of the smoke came locusts on the earth, and power was given to them, as the scorpions of the earth have power. ⁴They were told that they should not hurt the grass of the earth, neither any green thing, neither any tree, but only those people who don’t have God’s seal on their foreheads. ⁵They were given power, not to kill them, but to torment them for five months. Their torment was like the torment of a scorpion when it strikes a person. ⁶In those days people will seek death, and will in no way find it. They will desire to die, and death will flee from them. ⁷The shapes of the locusts were like horses prepared for war. On their heads were something like golden crowns, and their faces were like people’s faces. ⁸They had hair like women’s hair, and their teeth were like those of lions. ⁹They had breastplates like breastplates of iron. The sound of their wings was like the sound of many chariots and horses rushing to war. ¹⁰They have tails like those of scorpions, with stingers. In their tails they have power to harm men for five months. ¹¹They have over them as king the angel of the abyss. His name in Hebrew is “Abaddon”, ^{xxxi} but in Greek, he has the name “Apollyon”. ^{xxxii} ¹²The first woe is past. Behold, there are still two woes coming after this. ¹³The sixth angel sounded. I heard a voice from the horns of the golden altar which is before God, ¹⁴saying to the sixth angel who had the shofar, “Free the four angels who are bound at the great river Euphrates!” ¹⁵The four angels were freed who had been prepared for that hour and day and month and year, so that they might kill one third of mankind. ¹⁶The number of the armies of the horsemen was two hundred million. ^{xxxiii} I heard the number of them. ¹⁷Thus I saw the horses in the vision and those who sat on them, having breastplates of fiery red, hyacinth blue, and sulfur yellow; and the horses’ heads resembled lions’ heads. Out of their mouths proceed fire, smoke, and sulfur. ¹⁸By these three plagues, one third of mankind was killed: by the fire, the smoke, and the sulfur, which proceeded out of their mouths. ¹⁹For the power of the horses is in their mouths and in their tails. For their tails are like serpents, and have

heads; and with them they harm. ²⁰The rest of mankind, who were not killed with these plagues, didn’t repent of the works of their hands, that they wouldn’t worship demons, and the idols of gold, and of silver, and of brass, and of stone, and of wood, which can’t see, hear, or walk. ²¹They didn’t repent of their murders, their sorceries, ^{xxxiv} their sexual immorality, or their thefts.

¹⁰I saw a mighty angel coming down out of the sky, clothed with a cloud. A rainbow was on his head. His face was like the sun, and his feet like pillars of fire. ²He had in his hand a little open book. He set his right foot on the sea, and his left on the land. ³He cried with a loud voice, as a lion roars. When he cried, the seven thunders uttered their voices. ⁴When the seven thunders sounded, I was about to write; but I heard a voice from the sky saying, “Seal up the things which the seven thunders said, and don’t write them.” ⁵The angel whom I saw standing on the sea and on the land lifted up his right hand to the sky ⁶and swore by him who lives forever and ever, who created heaven and the things that are in it, the earth and the things that are in it, and the sea and the things that are in it, that there will no longer be delay, ⁷but in the days of the voice of the seventh angel, when he is about to sound, then the mystery of God is finished, as he declared to his servants the prophets. ⁸The voice which I heard from heaven, again speaking with me, said, “Go, take the book which is open in the hand of the angel who stands on the sea and on the land.” ⁹I went to the angel, telling him to give me the little book. He said to me, “Take it and eat it. It will make your stomach bitter, but in your mouth it will be as sweet as honey.” ¹⁰I took the little book out of the angel’s hand, and ate it. It was as sweet as honey in my mouth. When I had eaten it, my stomach was made bitter. ¹¹They ^{xxxv} told me, “You must prophesy again over many peoples, nations, languages, and kings.”

¹¹A reed like a rod was given to me. Someone said, “Rise and measure God’s temple, and the altar, and those who worship in it. ²Leave out the court which is outside of the temple, and don’t measure it, for it has been given to the nations. They will tread the holy city under foot for forty-two months. ³I will give power to my two witnesses, and they will prophesy one thousand two hundred sixty days, clothed in sackcloth.” ⁴These are the two olive trees and the two lamp stands, standing before the Lord of the earth. ⁵If anyone desires to harm them, fire proceeds out of their mouth and devours their enemies. If anyone desires to harm them, he must be killed in this way. ⁶These have the power to shut up the sky, that it may not rain during the days of their prophecy. They have power over the

^{xxix}or, trumpets

^{xxx}TR adds “great”

^{xxxi}“Abaddon” is a Hebrew word that means “ruin”, “destruction”, or “the place of destruction”

^{xxxii}“Apollyon” means “Destroyer”.

^{xxxiii}literally, “ten thousands of ten thousands”

^{xxxiv}The word for “sorceries” (pharmakeia) also implies the use of potions, poisons, and drugs

^{xxxv}TR reads “He” instead of “They”

waters, to turn them into blood, and to strike the earth with every plague, as often as they desire. ⁷When they have finished their testimony, the beast that comes up out of the abyss will make war with them, and overcome them, and kill them. ⁸Their dead bodies will be in the street of the great city, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, where also their Lord was crucified. ⁹From among the peoples, tribes, languages, and nations, people will look at their dead bodies for three and a half days, and will not allow their dead bodies to be laid in a tomb. ¹⁰Those who dwell on the earth will rejoice over them, and they will be glad. They will give gifts to one another, because these two prophets tormented those who dwell on the earth. ¹¹After the three and a half days, the breath of life from God entered into them, and they stood on their feet. Great fear fell on those who saw them. ¹²I heard a loud voice from heaven saying to them, "Come up here!" They went up into heaven in a cloud, and their enemies saw them. ¹³In that day there was a great earthquake, and a tenth of the city fell. Seven thousand people were killed in the earthquake, and the rest were terrified and gave glory to the God of heaven. ¹⁴The second woe is past. Behold, the third woe comes quickly. ¹⁵The seventh angel sounded, and great voices in heaven followed, saying, "The kingdom of the world has become the Kingdom of our Lord and of his Messiah. He will reign forever and ever!" ¹⁶The twenty-four elders, who sit on their thrones before God's throne, fell on their faces and worshiped God, ¹⁷saying: "We give you thanks, Lord God, the Almighty, the one who is and who was, ^{xxxvi} because you have taken your great power and reigned. ¹⁸The nations were angry, and your wrath came, as did the time for the dead to be judged, and to give your bondservants the prophets, their reward, as well as to the holy ones and those who fear your name, to the small and the great, and to destroy those who destroy the earth." ¹⁹God's temple that is in heaven was opened, and the ark of the Lord's covenant was seen in his temple. Lightnings, sounds, thunders, an earthquake, and great hail followed.

12A great sign was seen in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars. ²She was with child. She cried out in pain, laboring to give birth. ³Another sign was seen in heaven. Behold, a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and on his heads seven crowns. ⁴His tail drew one third of the stars of the sky, and threw them to the earth. The dragon stood before the woman who was about to give birth, so that when she gave birth he might devour her child. ⁵She gave birth to a son, a male child, who is to rule all the nations with a rod of iron. Her child was caught up to God and to his throne. ⁶The woman fled into the wilderness, where she has a place prepared by God, that there they may nourish her one thousand two

hundred sixty days. ⁷There was war in the sky. Michael and his angels made war on the dragon. The dragon and his angels made war. ⁸They didn't prevail. No place was found for them any more in heaven. ⁹The great dragon was thrown down, the old serpent, he who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him. ¹⁰I heard a loud voice in heaven, saying, "Now the salvation, the power, and the Kingdom of our God, and the authority of his Messiah has come; for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them before our God day and night. ¹¹They overcame him because of the Lamb's blood, and because of the word of their testimony. They didn't love their life, even to death. ¹²Therefore rejoice, heavens, and you who dwell in them. Woe to the earth and to the sea, because the devil has gone down to you, having great wrath, knowing that he has but a short time." ¹³When the dragon saw that he was thrown down to the earth, he persecuted the woman who gave birth to the male child. ¹⁴Two wings of the great eagle were given to the woman, that she might fly into the wilderness to her place, so that she might be nourished for a time, times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent. ¹⁵The serpent spewed water out of his mouth after the woman like a river, that he might cause her to be carried away by the stream. ¹⁶The earth helped the woman, and the earth opened its mouth and swallowed up the river which the dragon spewed out of his mouth. ¹⁷The dragon grew angry with the woman, and went away to make war with the rest of her offspring, ^{xxxvii} who keep God's commandments and hold Yeshua's testimony.

13Then I stood on the sand of the sea. I saw a beast coming up out of the sea, having ten horns and seven heads. On his horns were ten crowns, and on his heads, blasphemous names. ²The beast which I saw was like a leopard, and his feet were like those of a bear, and his mouth like the mouth of a lion. The dragon gave him his power, his throne, and great authority. ³One of his heads looked like it had been wounded fatally. His fatal wound was healed, and the whole earth marveled at the beast. ⁴They worshiped the dragon because he gave his authority to the beast; and they worshiped the beast, saying, "Who is like the beast? Who is able to make war with him?" ⁵A mouth speaking great things and blasphemy was given to him. Authority to make war for forty-two months was given to him. ⁶He opened his mouth for blasphemy against God, to blaspheme his name, his dwelling, and those who dwell in heaven. ⁷It was given to him to make war with the holy ones and to overcome them. Authority over every tribe, people, language, and nation was given to him. ⁸All who dwell on the earth will worship him, everyone whose name has not been written from the foundation of the world

^{xxxvi}TR adds "and who is coming"

^{xxxvii}or, seed

in the book of life of the Lamb who has been killed. ⁹If anyone has an ear, let him hear. ¹⁰If anyone is to go into captivity, he will go into captivity. If anyone is to be killed with the sword, he must be killed. ^{xxxviii} Here is the endurance and the faith of the holy ones. ¹¹I saw another beast coming up out of the earth. He had two horns like a lamb and it spoke like a dragon. ¹²He exercises all the authority of the first beast in his presence. He makes the earth and those who dwell in it to worship the first beast, whose fatal wound was healed. ¹³He performs great signs, even making fire come down out of the sky to the earth in the sight of people. ¹⁴He deceives my own ^{xxxix} people who dwell on the earth because of the signs he was granted to do in front of the beast, saying to those who dwell on the earth that they should make an image to the beast who had the sword wound and lived. ¹⁵It was given to him to give breath to the image of the beast, that the image of the beast should both speak, and cause as many as wouldn't worship the image of the beast to be killed. ¹⁶He causes all, the small and the great, the rich and the poor, and the free and the slave, to be given marks on their right hands or on their foreheads; ¹⁷and that no one would be able to buy or to sell unless he has that mark, which is the name of the beast or the number of his name. ¹⁸Here is wisdom. He who has understanding, let him calculate the number of the beast, for it is the number of a man. His number is six hundred sixty-six.

¹⁴I saw, and behold, the Lamb standing on Mount Zion, and with him a number, one hundred forty-four thousand, having his name and the name of his Father written on their foreheads. ²I heard a sound from heaven like the sound of many waters and like the sound of a great thunder. The sound which I heard was like that of harpists playing on their harps. ³They sing a new song before the throne and before the four living creatures and the elders. No one could learn the song except the one hundred forty-four thousand, those who had been redeemed out of the earth. ⁴These are those who were not defiled with women, for they are virgins. These are those who follow the Lamb wherever he goes. These were redeemed by Yeshua from among men, the first fruits to God and to the Lamb. ⁵In their mouth was found no lie, for they are blameless. ^{xi} ⁶I saw an angel flying in mid heaven, having an eternal Good News to proclaim to those who dwell on the earth—to every nation, tribe, language, and people. ⁷He said with a loud voice, "Fear the Lord, and give him glory, for the hour of his judgment has come. Worship him who made the heaven, the earth, the sea, and the springs of waters!"

^{xxxviii}TR reads "If anyone leads into captivity, into captivity he goes. If anyone will kill with the sword, he must be killed with a sword." instead of "If anyone is to go into captivity, he will go into captivity. If anyone is to be killed with the sword, he must be killed."

^{xxxix}NU omits "my own"

^{xi}TR adds "before the throne of God"

⁸Another, a second angel, followed, saying, "Babylon the great has fallen, which has made all the nations to drink of the wine of the wrath of her sexual immorality." ⁹Another angel, a third, followed them, saying with a great voice, "If anyone worships the beast and his image, and receives a mark on his forehead or on his hand, ¹⁰he also will drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is prepared unmixed in the cup of his anger. He will be tormented with fire and sulfur in the presence of the holy angels and in the presence of the Lamb. ¹¹The smoke of their torment goes up forever and ever. They have no rest day and night, those who worship the beast and his image, and whoever receives the mark of his name. ¹²Here is the perseverance of the holy ones, those who keep the commandments of God and the faith of Yeshua." ¹³I heard a voice from heaven saying, "Write, 'Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord from now on.'" "Yes," says the Spirit, "that they may rest from their labors, for their works follow with them." ¹⁴I looked, and saw a white cloud, and on the cloud one sitting like a son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle. ¹⁵Another angel came out of the temple, crying with a loud voice to him who sat on the cloud, "Send your sickle and reap, for the hour to reap has come; for the harvest of the earth is ripe!" ¹⁶He who sat on the cloud thrust his sickle on the earth, and the earth was reaped. ¹⁷Another angel came out of the temple which is in heaven. He also had a sharp sickle. ¹⁸Another angel came out from the altar, he who has power over fire, and he called with a great voice to him who had the sharp sickle, saying, "Send your sharp sickle and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth, for the earth's grapes are fully ripe!" ¹⁹The angel thrust his sickle into the earth, and gathered the vintage of the earth and threw it into the great wine press of the wrath of God. ²⁰The wine press was trodden outside of the city, and blood came out of the wine press, up to the bridles of the horses, as far as one thousand six hundred stadia. ^{xli}

¹⁵I saw another great and marvelous sign in the sky: seven angels having the seven last plagues, for in them God's wrath is finished. ²I saw something like a sea of glass mixed with fire, and those who overcame the beast, his image, ^{xlii} and the number of his name, standing on the sea of glass, having harps of God. ³They sang the song of Moses, the servant of God, and the song of the Lamb, saying, "Great and marvelous are your works, Lord God, the Almighty! Righteous and true are your ways, you King of the nations. ⁴Who wouldn't fear you, Lord, and glorify your name? For you only are holy. For all the nations will come and worship before you. For your righteous acts have been revealed." ⁵After these things I looked, and the temple of the tabernacle of the testimony

^{xli}1600 stadia = 296 kilometers or 184 miles

^{xlii}TR adds "his mark,"

in heaven was opened. ⁶The seven angels who had the seven plagues came out, clothed with pure, bright linen, and wearing golden sashes around their chests. ⁷One of the four living creatures gave to the seven angels seven golden bowls full of the wrath of God, who lives forever and ever. ⁸The temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God and from his power. No one was able to enter into the temple until the seven plagues of the seven angels would be finished.

16I heard a loud voice out of the temple, saying to the seven angels, “Go and pour out the seven bowls of the wrath of God on the earth!” ²The first went, and poured out his bowl into the earth, and it became a harmful and painful sore on the people who had the mark of the beast, and who worshiped his image. ³The second angel poured out his bowl into the sea, and it became blood as of a dead man. Every living thing in the sea died. ⁴The third poured out his bowl into the rivers and springs of water, and they became blood. ⁵I heard the angel of the waters saying, “You are righteous, who are and who were, O Holy One, because you have judged these things. ⁶For they poured out the blood of holy ones and prophets, and you have given them blood to drink. They deserve this.” ⁷I heard the altar saying, “Yes, Lord God, the Almighty, true and righteous are your judgments.” ⁸The fourth poured out his bowl on the sun, and it was given to him to scorch men with fire. ⁹People were scorched with great heat, and people blasphemed the name of God who has the power over these plagues. They didn’t repent and give him glory. ¹⁰The fifth poured out his bowl on the throne of the beast, and his kingdom was darkened. They gnawed their tongues because of the pain, ¹¹and they blasphemed the God of heaven because of their pains and their sores. They still didn’t repent of their works. ¹²The sixth poured out his bowl on the great river, the Euphrates. Its water was dried up, that the way might be prepared for the kings that come from the sunrise. ^{xliii} ¹³I saw coming out of the mouth of the dragon, and out of the mouth of the beast, and out of the mouth of the false prophet, three unclean spirits, something like frogs; ¹⁴for they are spirits of demons, performing signs, which go out to the kings of the whole inhabited earth, to gather them together for the war of that great day of God the Almighty. ¹⁵“Behold, I come like a thief. Blessed is he who watches, and keeps his clothes, so that he doesn’t walk naked, and they see his shame.” ¹⁶He gathered them together into the place which is called in Hebrew, “Harmagedon”. ¹⁷The seventh poured out his bowl into the air. A loud voice came out of the temple of heaven, from the throne, saying, “It is done!” ¹⁸There were lightnings, sounds, and thunders; and there was a great earthquake such as has not happened since there were men on the earth—so great an earthquake and

so mighty. ¹⁹The great city was divided into three parts, and the cities of the nations fell. Babylon the great was remembered in the sight of God, to give to her the cup of the wine of the fierceness of his wrath. ²⁰Every island fled away, and the mountains were not found. ²¹Great hailstones, about the weight of a talent, ^{xliv} came down out of the sky on people. People blasphemed God because of the plague of the hail, for this plague was exceedingly severe.

17One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls came and spoke with me, saying, “Come here. I will show you the judgment of the great prostitute who sits on many waters, ²with whom the kings of the earth committed sexual immorality. Those who dwell in the earth were made drunken with the wine of her sexual immorality.” ³He carried me away in the Spirit into a wilderness. I saw a woman sitting on a scarlet-colored beast, full of blasphemous names, having seven heads and ten horns. ⁴The woman was dressed in purple and scarlet, and decked with gold and precious stones and pearls, having in her hand a golden cup full of abominations and the impurities of the sexual immorality of the earth. ⁵And on her forehead a name was written, “MYSTERY, BABYLON THE GREAT, THE MOTHER OF THE PROSTITUTES AND OF THE ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH.” ⁶I saw the woman drunken with the blood of the holy ones and with the blood of the martyrs of Yeshua. When I saw her, I wondered with great amazement. ⁷The angel said to me, “Why do you wonder? I will tell you the mystery of the woman and of the beast that carries her, which has the seven heads and the ten horns. ⁸The beast that you saw was, and is not; and is about to come up out of the abyss and to go into destruction. Those who dwell on the earth and whose names have not been written in the book of life from the foundation of the world will marvel when they see that the beast was, and is not, and shall be present. ^{xlv} ⁹Here is the mind that has wisdom. The seven heads are seven mountains on which the woman sits. ¹⁰They are seven kings. Five have fallen, the one is, and the other has not yet come. When he comes, he must continue a little while. ¹¹The beast that was, and is not, is himself also an eighth, and is of the seven; and he goes to destruction. ¹²The ten horns that you saw are ten kings who have received no kingdom as yet, but they receive authority as kings with the beast for one hour. ¹³These have one mind, and they give their power and authority to the beast. ¹⁴These will war against the Lamb, and the Lamb will overcome them, for he is Lord of lords and King of kings; and those who are with him are called, chosen, and faithful.” ¹⁵He said to me, “The waters which you saw, where the prostitute sits, are peoples, multitudes, nations, and languages. ¹⁶The ten horns which you saw, they and

^{xliv}A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

^{xlv}TR reads “yet is” instead of “shall be present”

^{xliii}or, east

the beast will hate the prostitute, will make her desolate, will strip her naked, will eat her flesh, and will burn her utterly with fire. ¹⁷For God has put in their hearts to do what he has in mind, to be of one mind, and to give their kingdom to the beast, until the words of God should be accomplished. ¹⁸The woman whom you saw is the great city which reigns over the kings of the earth."

18After these things, I saw another angel coming down out of the sky, having great authority. The earth was illuminated with his glory. ²He cried with a mighty voice, saying, "Fallen, fallen is Babylon the great, and she has become a habitation of demons, a prison of every unclean spirit, and a prison of every unclean and hated bird! ³For all the nations have drunk of the wine of the wrath of her sexual immorality, the kings of the earth committed sexual immorality with her, and the merchants of the earth grew rich from the abundance of her luxury." ⁴I heard another voice from heaven, saying, "Come out of her, my people, that you have no participation in her sins, and that you don't receive of her plagues, ⁵for her sins have reached to the sky, and God has remembered her iniquities. ⁶Return to her just as she returned, and repay her double as she did, and according to her works. In the cup which she mixed, mix to her double. ⁷However much she glorified herself and grew wanton, so much give her of torment and mourning. For she says in her heart, 'I sit a queen, and am no widow, and will in no way see mourning.' ⁸Therefore in one day her plagues will come: death, mourning, and famine; and she will be utterly burned with fire, for the Lord God who has judged her is strong. ⁹The kings of the earth who committed sexual immorality and lived wantonly with her will weep and wail over her, when they look at the smoke of her burning, ¹⁰standing far away for the fear of her torment, saying, 'Woe, woe, the great city, Babylon, the strong city! For your judgment has come in one hour.' ¹¹The merchants of the earth weep and mourn over her, for no one buys their merchandise any more: ¹²merchandise of gold, silver, precious stones, pearls, fine linen, purple, silk, scarlet, all expensive wood, every vessel of ivory, every vessel made of most precious wood, and of brass, and iron, and marble; ¹³and cinnamon, incense, perfume, frankincense, wine, olive oil, fine flour, wheat, sheep, horses, chariots, and people's bodies and souls. ¹⁴The fruits which your soul lusted after have been lost to you. All things that were dainty and sumptuous have perished from you, and you will find them no more at all. ¹⁵The merchants of these things, who were made rich by her, will stand far away for the fear of her torment, weeping and mourning, ¹⁶saying, 'Woe, woe, the great city, she who was dressed in fine linen, purple, and scarlet, and decked with gold and precious stones and pearls! ¹⁷For in an hour such great riches are made desolate.' Every ship master, and everyone who sails anywhere, and mariners,

and as many as gain their living by sea, stood far away, ¹⁸and cried out as they looked at the smoke of her burning, saying, 'What is like the great city?' ¹⁹They cast dust on their heads, and cried, weeping and mourning, saying, 'Woe, woe, the great city, in which all who had their ships in the sea were made rich by reason of her great wealth!' For she is made desolate in one hour. ²⁰"Rejoice over her, O heaven, you holy ones, emissaries, and prophets, for God has judged your judgment on her." ²¹A mighty angel took up a stone like a great millstone and cast it into the sea, saying, "Thus with violence will Babylon, the great city, be thrown down, and will be found no more at all. ²²The voice of harpists, minstrels, flute players, and trumpeters will be heard no more at all in you. No craftsman of whatever craft will be found any more at all in you. The sound of a mill will be heard no more at all in you. ²³The light of a lamp will shine no more at all in you. The voice of the bridegroom and of the bride will be heard no more at all in you, for your merchants were the princes of the earth; for with your sorcery all the nations were deceived. ²⁴In her was found the blood of prophets and of holy ones, and of all who have been slain on the earth."

19After these things I heard something like a loud voice of a great multitude in heaven, saying, "Hallelujah! Salvation, power, and glory belong to our God; ²for his judgments are true and righteous. For he has judged the great prostitute who corrupted the earth with her sexual immorality, and he has avenged the blood of his servants at her hand." ³A second said, "Hallelujah! Her smoke goes up forever and ever." ⁴The twenty-four elders and the four living creatures fell down and worshiped God who sits on the throne, saying, "Amen! Hallelujah!" ⁵A voice came from the throne, saying, "Give praise to our God, all you his servants, you who fear him, the small and the great!" ⁶I heard something like the voice of a great multitude, and like the voice of many waters, and like the voice of mighty thunders, saying, "Hallelujah! For the Lord our God, the Almighty, reigns! ⁷Let's rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and let's give the glory to him. For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his wife has made herself ready." ⁸It was given to her that she would array herself in bright, pure, fine linen, for the fine linen is the righteous acts of the holy ones. ⁹He said to me, "Write, 'Blessed are those who are invited to the wedding supper of the Lamb.'" He said to me, "These are true words of God." ¹⁰I fell down before his feet to worship him. He said to me, "Look! Don't do it! I am a fellow bondservant with you and with your brothers who hold the testimony of Yeshua. Worship God, for the testimony of Yeshua is the Spirit of Prophecy." ¹¹I saw the heaven opened, and behold, a white horse, and he who sat on it is called Faithful and True. In righteousness he judges and makes war. ¹²His eyes are a flame of fire, and on his head are many crowns. He has names written and

a name written which no one knows but he himself. ¹³He is clothed in a garment sprinkled with blood. His name is called "The Word of God." ¹⁴The armies which are in heaven, clothed in white, pure, fine linen, followed him on white horses. ¹⁵Out of his mouth proceeds a sharp, double-edged sword that with it he should strike the nations. He will rule them with an iron rod. He treads the wine press of the fierceness of the wrath of God, the Almighty. ¹⁶He has on his garment and on his thigh a name written, "KING OF KINGS AND LORD OF LORDS." ¹⁷I saw an angel standing in the sun. He cried with a loud voice, saying to all the birds that fly in the sky, "Come! Be gathered together to the great supper of God, ^{xlvi} ¹⁸that you may eat the flesh of kings, the flesh of captains, the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses and of those who sit on them, and the flesh of all men, both free and slave, small and great." ¹⁹I saw the beast, the kings of the earth, and their armies, gathered together to make war against him who sat on the horse and against his army. ²⁰The beast was taken, and with him the false prophet who worked the signs in his sight, with which he deceived those who had received the mark of the beast and those who worshiped his image. These two were thrown alive into the lake of fire that burns with sulfur. ²¹The rest were killed with the sword of him who sat on the horse, the sword which came out of his mouth. So all the birds were filled with their flesh.

²⁰I saw an angel coming down out of heaven, having the key of the abyss and a great chain in his hand. ²He seized the dragon, the old serpent, who is the devil and Satan, who deceives the whole inhabited earth, ^{xlvii} and bound him for a thousand years, ³and cast him into the abyss, and shut it and sealed it over him, that he should deceive the nations no more until the thousand years were finished. After this, he must be freed for a short time. ⁴I saw thrones, and they sat on them, and judgment was given to them. I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded for the testimony of Yeshua and for the word of God, and such as didn't worship the beast nor his image, and didn't receive the mark on their forehead and on their hand. They lived and reigned with Messiah for a thousand years. ⁵The rest of the dead didn't live until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection. ⁶Blessed and holy is he who has part in the first resurrection. Over these, the second death has no power, but they will be priests of God and of Messiah, and will reign with him one thousand years. ⁷And after the thousand years, Satan will be released from his prison ⁸and he will come out to deceive the nations which are in the four corners of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them together to the

war, whose number is as the sand of the sea. ⁹They went up over the width of the earth and surrounded the camp of the holy ones and the beloved city. Fire came down out of heaven from God and devoured them. ¹⁰The devil who deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet are also. They will be tormented day and night forever and ever. ¹¹I saw a great white throne and him who sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away. There was found no place for them. ¹²I saw the dead, the great and the small, standing before the throne, and they opened books. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged out of the things which were written in the books, according to their works. ¹³The sea gave up the dead who were in it. Death and Sheol ^{xlviii} gave up the dead who were in them. They were judged, each one according to his works. ¹⁴Death and Sheol ^{xlix} were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire. ¹⁵If anyone was not found written in the book of life, he was cast into the lake of fire.

²¹I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth have passed away, and the sea is no more. ²I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared like a bride adorned for her husband. ³I heard a loud voice out of heaven saying, "Behold, God's dwelling is with people; and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. ⁴He will wipe away every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; neither will there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain any more. The first things have passed away." ⁵He who sits on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new." He said, "Write, for these words of God are faithful and true." ⁶He said to me, "I am the Alef and the Tav, the Beginning and the End. I will give freely to him who is thirsty from the spring of the water of life. ⁷He who overcomes, I will give him these things. I will be his God, and he will be my son. ⁸But for the cowardly, unbelieving, sinners, ¹ abominable, murderers, sexually immoral, sorcerers, ^{li} idolaters, and all liars, their part is in the lake that burns with fire and sulfur, which is the second death." ⁹One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls which were loaded with the seven last plagues came, and he spoke with me, saying, "Come here. I will show you the bride, the Lamb's wife." ¹⁰He carried me away in the Spirit to a great and high mountain, and showed me the holy city, Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, ¹¹having the glory of God. Her light was like a most precious stone, like a

^{xlviii}or, Hell

^{xlix}or, Hell

¹TR and NU omit "sinners"

^{li}The word for "sorcerers" here also includes users of potions and drugs.

^{xlvi}TR reads "supper of the great God" instead of "great supper of God"

^{xlvii}TR and NU omit "who deceives the whole inhabited earth".

jasper stone, clear as crystal; ¹²having a great and high wall with twelve gates, and at the gates twelve angels, and names written on them, which are the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel. ¹³On the east were three gates, and on the north three gates, and on the south three gates, and on the west three gates. ¹⁴The wall of the city had twelve foundations, and on them twelve names of the twelve Emissaries of the Lamb. ¹⁵He who spoke with me had for a measure a golden reed to measure the city, its gates, and its walls. ¹⁶The city is square. Its length is as great as its width. He measured the city with the reed: twelve thousand twelve stadia. ^{lii} Its length, width, and height are equal. ¹⁷Its wall is one hundred forty-four cubits, ^{liii} by the measure of a man, that is, of an angel. ¹⁸The construction of its wall was jasper. The city was pure gold, like pure glass. ¹⁹The foundations of the city's wall were adorned with all kinds of precious stones. The first foundation was jasper, the second sapphire; ^{liv} the third chalcedony, the fourth emerald, ²⁰the fifth sardonyx, the sixth sardius, the seventh chrysolite, the eighth beryl, the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprase, the eleventh jacinth, and the twelfth amethyst. ²¹The twelve gates were twelve pearls. Each one of the gates was made of one pearl. The street of the city was pure gold, like transparent glass. ²²I saw no temple in it, for the Lord God the Almighty and the Lamb are its temple. ²³The city has no need for the sun or moon to shine, for the very glory of God illuminated it and its lamp is the Lamb. ²⁴The nations will walk in its light. The kings of the earth bring the glory and honor of the nations into it. ²⁵Its gates will in no way be shut by day (for there will be no night there), ²⁶and they shall bring the glory and the honor of the nations into it so that they may enter. ²⁷There will in no way enter into it anything profane, or one who causes an abomination or a lie, but only those who are written in the Lamb's book of life.

22He showed me a ^{lv} river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb, ²in the middle of its street. On this side of the river and on that was the tree of life, bearing twelve kinds of fruits, yielding its fruit every month. The leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations. ³There will be no curse any more. The throne of God and of the Lamb will be in it, and his servants will serve him. ⁴They will see his face, and his name will be on their foreheads. ⁵There will be no night, and they need no lamp light or sun light; for the Lord God will illuminate them. They will reign forever and ever. ⁶He said to me, "These words are faithful and true. The Lord God of the spirits of the

prophets sent his angel to show to his bondservants the things which must happen soon." ⁷"Behold, I am coming soon! Blessed is he who keeps the words of the prophecy of this book." ⁸Now I, Yochanan, am the one who heard and saw these things. When I heard and saw, I fell down to worship before the feet of the angel who had shown me these things. ⁹He said to me, "You must not do that! I am a fellow bondservant with you and with your brothers, the prophets, and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God." ¹⁰He said to me, "Don't seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the time is at hand. ¹¹He who acts unjustly, let him act unjustly still. He who is filthy, let him be filthy still. He who is righteous, let him do righteousness still. He who is holy, let him be holy still." ¹²"Behold, I am coming soon! My reward is with me, to repay to each man according to his work. ¹³I am the Alef and the Tav, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End. ¹⁴Blessed are those who do his commandments, ^{lvi} that they may have the right to the tree of life, and may enter in by the gates into the city. ¹⁵Outside are the dogs, the sorcerers, the sexually immoral, the murderers, the idolaters, and everyone who loves and practices falsehood. ¹⁶I, Yeshua, have sent my angel to testify these things to you for the assemblies. I am the root and the offspring of David, the Bright and Morning Star." ¹⁷The Spirit and the bride say, "Come!" He who hears, let him say, "Come!" He who is thirsty, let him come. He who desires, let him take the water of life freely. ¹⁸I testify to everyone who hears the words of the prophecy of this book: if anyone adds to them, God will add to him the plagues which are written in this book. ¹⁹If anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God will take away his part from the tree ^{lvii} of life, and out of the holy city, which are written in this book. ²⁰He who testifies these things says, "Yes, I am coming soon." Amen! Yes, come, Lord Yeshua! ²¹The grace of the Lord Yeshua the Messiah be with all the holy ones. Amen.

^{lii}12,012 stadia = or 2,221 kilometers or 1,380 miles. TR reads 12,000 stadia instead of 12,012 stadia.

^{liii}144 cubits is about 65.8 meters or 216 feet

^{liv}or, lapis lazuli

^{lv}TR adds "pure"

^{lvi}NU reads "wash their robes" instead of "do his commandments".

^{lvii}TR reads "Book" instead of "tree"